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RIG-VEDA SAMHITA

ಋಗ್ವೇದಸಂಹಿತಾ

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Sūktas 1–18 · Aṣṭaka 3

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with the Bhāṣya of Sāyaṇācārya and the Kannada Commentary of H. P. Venkata Rao

Volume 17 · Maṇḍala 3 · Sūktas 40–62 and Maṇḍala 4 · Sūktas 1–18

English Translation by

Bhargavi Upadhya

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Preface to the English edition

[To be written by the translator-editor.]

Preface of the original edition

This portion of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā contains the exposition of the great Gāyatrī mantra. Just as the Ṛgveda holds the first place among the four Vedas, so too the Gāyatrī mantra holds the foremost place among all mantras. It is necessary to examine how this great mantra came to have such pre-eminence.

The deity celebrated in the Gāyatrī mantra is Savitṛ, and Savitṛ is the Sun. The Ṛgveda has many words denoting the Sun deity: Mitra, Ravi, Sūrya, Bhānu, Khaga, Pūṣa, Hiraṇyagarbha, Marīci, Āditya, Savitṛ, Arka and Bhāskara. Although these twelve names denote the Sun, three of them, Savitṛ, Sūrya and Āditya, are the chief ones. Moreover, although these three words indicate one and the same person, the Sun, in the mantras of the Ṛgveda they are praised as if they were separate deities, according to their respective qualities. Thus: Savitṛ is the Sun who is just then rising. Sūrya is the Sun who shines from after sunrise until the time of sunset. Āditya is the deity who comprises all the features of the Sun's form; that is, in Āditya are found both the distinction of Savitṛ and the distinction of Sūrya, and furthermore the Supreme Reality (Parabrahman), the very root of the world (the universe), is described in the form of the deity called Āditya.

Although the Ṛgveda has many mantras addressed to the Sun deity (Savitṛ, Sūrya, Āditya and so on), why does this Gāyatrī mantra, addressed to Savitṛ, have such pre-eminence? Among metres, the Gāyatrī metre is the most excellent. By Gāyatrī metre is meant, as stated in the Śruti sentences अष्टाक्षरा गायत्रि (*aṣṭākṣarā gāyatri*) and त्रिपदा गायत्रि (*tripadā gāyatri*), a Ṛk with three pādas of eight syllables each. This Ṛk has two pādas of eight syllables each in the first half and one pāda in the second half, twenty-four syllables in all. As stated in the Śruti sentences अग्निर्वै देवानामवमो विष्णुः परमस्तदंतरेण सर्वा अन्या देवताः (*agnirvai devānāmavamo viṣṇuḥ paramastadaṃtareṇa sarvā anyā devatāḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 1-1) and अग्निरग्रे प्रथमो देवतानां । संयातानामुत्तमो विष्णुरासीत् (*agniragre prathamo devatānāṃ | saṃyātānāmuttamo viṣṇurāsīt*) (Tai. Brā.

2-4-3-3), in the list of deities Agni has the first place and Viṣṇu the last. In the same way, गायत्रिं छंदसां माता (*gāyatriṃ chaṃdasāṃ mātā*) (Tai. U. 4-34): the Gāyatrī metre too has the foremost place among metres. When sacrifice is performed in the three classes, Brāhmaṇa, Kṣatriya and Vaiśya: गायत्रिभिब्राह्मणस्यादध्यात्। गायत्रछंदा वै ब्राह्मणः । स्वस्य छंदसः प्रत्ययनस्त्वाय । त्रिष्टुघ्री राजन्यस्य । त्रिष्टुप्छंदा वै (*gāyatribhibrāhmaṇasyādadhyāt*| *gāyatrachaṃdā vai brāhmaṇaḥ* | *svasya chaṃdasaḥ pratyayanastvāya* | *triṣṭughrī rājanyasya* | *triṣṭupchaṃdā vai*)

… Brahman. Although he is spoken of by many names such as Savitṛ, Sūrya and Āditya, there is no doubt whatever that he is Brahman. On this matter there are as many Śruti testimonies as one could wish:

आदित्यो वै तेज ओजो बलं यशश्चक्षुः श्रोत्रमात्मा मनो मन्युर्मनुर्मृत्युः सत्यो मित्रो वायुराकाशः प्राणो लोकपालः कः किं कं तत्सत्यमन्नममृतो जीवो विश्वः कतमः स्वयंभु ब्रह्मैतदमृत एष पुरुष एष भूतानामधिपतिर्ब्रह्मणः सायुज्यगं् सलोकतामाप्नोत्येतासामेव देवतानागं् सायुज्यगं् सार्षितागं् समानलोकतामाप्नोति य एवं वेदेत्युपनिषत् ॥ (*ādityo vai teja ojo balaṃ yaśaścakṣuḥ śrotramātmā mano manyurmanurmṛtyuḥ satyo mitro vāyurākāśaḥ prāṇo lokapālaḥ kaḥ kiṃ kaṃ tatsatyamannamamṛto jīvo viśvaḥ katamaḥ svayaṃbhu brahmaitadamṛta eṣa puruṣa eṣa bhūtānāmadhipatirbrahmaṇaḥ sāyujyagṃ salokatāmāpnotyetāsāmeva devatānāgṃ sāyujyagṃ sārṣitāgṃ samānalokatāmāpnoti ya evaṃ vedetyupaniṣat ‖*)

(Tai. U. 4-15)[?1]

This Āditya (this Sun visible to our eyes) is endowed with radiance; he is of the nature of strength; the energy in the body; fame; the external organs, eye and ear; the body; the mind; anger, the property of the mind; Manu, such as Svāyambhuva; Yama, called Death; truth; Mitra; wind; space; breath; the guardian of the world (or the presiding deity of qualities such as truth); Prajāpati; whatever indeterminate thing remains yet unsaid; happiness; the Supreme Reality; freedom from untruth; food such as rice; life-span; deathlessness; the many kinds of jīva or ātman; the Prajāpati of surpassing bliss, unborn; the protector of all beings. All the things of whatever kind that exist in this world are this Āditya, that is, Brahman in the form of Āditya. The person who worships this

Puruṣa (named Āditya), lord of all beings and the self of all, attains the status of Brahman, that is, Brahma-sāyujya (union with Brahman). Worship is of two kinds. If one worships with the notion that everything is Parabrahman, one attains Brahma-sāyujya. If instead one worships in the ordinary way, that is, with devotion regarding him as a deity, one attains the worlds of those respective deities (Indra and the other deities), that is, heaven and the other worlds, and enjoys happiness. This is the chief purport of this mantra. Since it is stated that this Āditya is of the nature of all things, and since only the Brahman reality is of that kind, it has become clear that this Āditya is Parabrahman.

आदित्यो वा एष एतन्मंडलं तपति तत्र ता ऋचस्तदृचा मंडलग्० स ऋचां लोकोऽथ य एष एतस्मिन्मंडलेऽर्चिर्दिप्यते तानि सामानि स साम्यां लोकोऽथ य एष एतस्मिन्मंडलेऽर्चिषि पुरुषस्तानि यजूग्ंषि स यजुषा मंडलग्० स यजुषां लोकः सैषा त्रय्येव विद्या तपति य एषोन्तरादित्ये हिरण्मयः पुरुषः ॥ (*āditya vā eṣa etanmaṃḍalaṃ tapati tatra tā ṛcastadṛcā maṃḍalago sa ṛcāṃ loko 'tha ya eṣa etasminmaṃḍale 'rcirdipyate tāni sāmāni sa sāmyāṃ loko 'tha ya eṣa etasminmaṃḍale 'rciṣi puruṣastāni yajūgṃṣi sa yajuṣā maṃḍalago sa yajuṣāṃ lokaḥ saiṣā trayyeva vidyā tapati ya eṣontarāditye hiraṇmayaḥ puruṣaḥ ॥*)

(Kṛ. U. 4-14)[?2]

This Āditya is the Supreme Lord. This Āditya, visible to our eyes, shines with tejas (extreme brilliance). In that orb of radiance in which he shines, all the Ṛk verses of the Ṛgveda are established; that is, the solar orb, formed of the Ṛgveda, is the world, the dwelling-place, of the deities presiding over the Ṛks. In the same way, since in this mass of radiance there are also the Sāma mantras, Bṛhat, Rathantara and the rest, in the form of flames, it is also the dwelling-place of the deities presiding over the Sāma mantras. Next, since there are Yajus mantras too in this orb, the world of the deities presiding over the Yajus mantras is also there. Therefore the purport is that Āditya, who shines in the very form of the mantras of the Ṛgveda, Yajurveda and Sāmaveda, blazes in this orb of radiance in a golden (that is, gold-made) form, resplendent with great brilliance like gold.

These mantras, and many other mantras such as सूर्य आत्मा जगतस्तस्थुषश्च (*sūrya ātmā jagatastasthuṣaśca*), praise the Parabrahman nature of Sūrya (or Āditya). For this very reason there is the injunction that the twice-born must perform worship of the Sun every day. This worship of the Sun takes the form of the Sandhyā-vandana. The Sandhyā-vandana has three main parts: offering of arghya, japa of the Gāyatrī mantra, and upasthāna. These three acts are all worship of the Sun. Although the Sandhyā-vandana also has acts such as mārjana (sprinkling), these are acts performed for purification of the body. The three acts beginning with the offering of arghya are the principal ones. Before the japa of the Gāyatrī mantra, one invokes the goddess with mantras beginning अयातु वरदा देवी (*ayātu varadā devī*), purifies the body with nyāsa, meditates with one-pointed attention, and then performs the japa. After the japa, one performs the dismissal of Gāyatrī, preceded by the mantra उत्तमे शिखरे जाते (*uttame śikhare jāte*), and then performs the upasthāna. The rite performed in this manner is called Sandhyā-vandana. At midday too one must perform the midday rite, which includes worship of the Sun. The Śruti itself describes in this way the greatness of the Gāyatrī mantra, the Sandhyā-vandana, its greatness, and the fruit obtained by its performance:

रक्षाग्ंसि हवा पुरोऽनुवाकेतपोग्रमतिष्ठंत तान्प्रजापतिर्वरेणोपामंत्रयत तानि वरमवृणीतादित्यो नो योद्धा इति तान्प्रजापतिरब्रवीद्योधयध्वमिति तस्मादुत्तिष्ठंतग्ं हवा तानि रक्षाग्स्यादित्यं योधयंति यावदस्तमन्वगात्तानि हवा एतानि रक्षाग्ंसि गायत्रियाभिमंत्रितेनांभसा शाम्यंति तदु हवा एते ब्रह्मनादिनः पूर्वाभिमुखाः संध्यायां गायत्रियाभिमंत्रिता आप ऊर्ध्वं विक्षिपंति ता एता आपो वज्री भूत्वा तानि रक्षाग्ंसि मंदे हारुणे द्वीपे प्रक्षिपंति यत्पदक्षिणं प्रक्रमंति तेन पाप्मानमवधून्वंत्युद्यंतमस्तंयंतमादित्यमभिध्याय- न्कुर्वन् ब्राह्मणो विद्वान्त कलं भद्रमश्नुतेऽसावादित्यो ब्रह्मेति ब्रह्मव सन्नह्याप्येति य एवं वेद ॥ (*rakṣāgsi havā puro 'nuvāke tapogramatiṣṭhaṃta tānprajāpatirvareṇopāmaṃtrayata tāni varamavṛṇītādityo no yoddhā iti tānprajāpatirabravīdyodhayadhvamiti tasmāduttiṣṭhaṃtagṃ havā tāni rakṣāgsyādityaṃ yodhayaṃti yāvadastamanvagāttāni havā etāni rakṣāgsi gāyatriyābhimaṃtritenāṃbhasā śāmyaṃti tadu havā ete brahmanādinaḥ pūrvābhimukhāḥ saṃdhyāyāṃ gāyatriyābhimaṃtritā āpa ūrdhvaṃ vikṣipaṃti tā etā āpo vajrī bhūtvā tāni rakṣāgsi maṃde hāruṇe dvīpe prakṣipaṃti yatpadakṣiṇaṃ prakramaṃti tena* *pāpmānamavadhūnvaṃtyudyaṃtamastaṃyaṃtamādityamabhidhyāyankurvan brāhmaṇo vidvānta kalaṃ bhadramaśnute 'sāvādityo brahmeti brahmava sannahyāpyeti ya evaṃ veda ||*)

(Tai. Ā. 2.2)?3

In former times the rākṣasas practised fierce austerity. Then the god Prajāpati appeared and asked them what boon they wanted. They prayed, "Grant us the power and the opportunity to fight with the Sun." Prajāpati consented, saying, "So be it." For that reason, as soon as the Sun rises the rākṣasas set out to fight with him and go on fighting until the time of setting. But they can be driven away by water purified by the recitation of the Gāyatrī. For that reason the Brahmavādins, at morning twilight (and at evening twilight too), recite the Gāyatrī and offer arghya with the water purified by it. These drops of water offered in the form of arghya turn into thunderbolts and hurl the rākṣasas into the island called Mandehāruṇa. Then the Brahmavādins rid themselves of their sin by the rite accompanied by circumambulation and salutation. The Brāhmaṇa (the knower of Brahman) who knows this truth, if he recites the Gāyatrī and offers arghya both at sunrise and at sunset, and through it worships and meditates on Āditya, obtains every kind of good fortune (welfare). This is the praise of the Gāyatrī recitation: the man who worships, knowing that Āditya is Parabrahman and that Āditya, the object of the Gāyatrī's worship, is Brahman, attains Brahma-sāyujya and becomes of the very form of Brahman.

It has been believed from ancient times that the rays of the Sun have the property of curing certain diseases (especially skin diseases). The present medical opinion supports this very view. There is also a practice of following a course of treatment called "sun-bath" (printed in English). All agree that exposing the body every day, even for a little while, to the light and warmth of the Sun is a great help to bodily health. Among the seers of the Ṛgveda, the seer Praskaṇva prayed to the Sun for the removal of the heart disease and skin disease (leucoderma) that had afflicted him (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1, Sūkta 50). The great sage Agastya prayed to the Sun for the removal of poison (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1, Sūkta 191). In the same way many seers have praised the Sun for the cure of disease. It may be said confidently that it is for these reasons that the vow (rite) called Sūrya-namaskāra has come into practice, and that the belief that it brings relief from disease is not without foundation.

From the standpoint of modern science too, it is necessary to know to what extent Āditya or the Sun is important. "As far as this earth is concerned, the sun is the source of all energy and activity." (printed in English) In the external world the Sun is the support of all the movements and activities that we carry on. The food we eat, the water we drink, the air we breathe,

the clothes we use, all kinds of vehicles used for travel and the like: for all these the light and heat (energy) that we get from the Sun are the cause, directly and indirectly. How? The things we take, such as food, are obtained only with the help of the five elements: pṛthivī (solid matter), ap (water), tejas (heat or energy), vāyu (air) and ākāśa (sky or space). None of these is possible without the power of the Sun's rays. Vegetarian food and meat food alike arise from the five elements. For this the power of the Sun's rays (heat or energy) is absolutely necessary. Without sunlight neither plants nor animals can live. It is with the Sun's help that from the five elements beginning with earth the plant kingdom, and from the plant kingdom the animal kingdom, arise and grow. These provide us with earthy (solid) food. In the food we eat, solid matter must be in a proper, definite proportion. Then the liquid element related to ap (fluid or water), that is, water, must be in our food in greater proportion than solid matter. In our body the fluid substance is more than half. In matters of food, the liquid (water) is more necessary than solid matter. One can live many days without food containing solid matter. But without drinking water (or taking any other kind of liquid) one cannot live more than three or four days. Tejas (heat) is more necessary than these two. Without heat in the body one cannot live more than a few hours. There are instances of many having died in cold regions, caught in a freezing wind. Air is more necessary than these three. Without air one cannot live more than five or six minutes. For the movements of our body and for other activities, ākāśa (space, room) is the most necessary of all. All these substances come to us from the Sun alone. It has been said earlier that without the Sun's light and heat no food, derived from plants or animals, can reach us. The same applies to the water we drink. The sea is the chief source of all water on earth, and no one can drink the salt water of the sea. The sea water is heated by the heat of the Sun's fierce rays, is converted into vapour, becomes cloud in the sky, and from it rain falls on the earth. This rain water alone is fit for the use of all living beings on earth. Rain water is the basis of all (fresh-water) reservoirs such as rivers, lakes, tanks and wells. Rain can come only through the heat of the Sun. The air we breathe also does not reach us without the Sun's help. If air stays in one place without movement, it is not fit for breathing. The Sun's heat is the cause of the movements of the air. The heat in our body too has the Sun as its cause, directly or indirectly. We may get heat directly from the Sun, or from the food we take. However we get it,

it is got only through the Sun's direct or indirect means. All this concerns food. Without the Sun's light we could not see external objects with our eyes. (The power of the Sun is the basis even of other kinds of light, such as lamps.) Our movements, the means of travel and the like, and all other activities go on only through the power of the Sun. Besides being the cause of these conditions of the external world, he is also present in the heart of us (of all living beings) as the inner self, and impels the matters we think of in the mind and the acts we perform. That is, as the Śruti sentence सूर्य आत्मा जगतस्तस्थुषश्च (*sūrya ātmā jagatastasthuṣaśca*) says, the Sun himself dwells in us as consciousness and is the cause of all our acts. This Āditya (the Sun) is also, in the form of Time, the cause of the world's activities.

कलात्स्रवंति भूतानि कालाद्वृद्धिं प्रयांति च । काले चास्तं नियच्छंति कालो मूर्तिरमूर्तिमान् ॥
(*kalātsravaṃti bhūtāni kālādvṛddhiṃ prayāṃti ca | kāle cāstaṃ niyacchaṃti kālo mūrtiramūrtimān* ‖)[?4]

From Time in the form of Āditya or in the form of the year, all beings move about and grow, and at the end reach asta (destruction). Therefore the whole world of moving and unmoving things is subject to Time. The Upaniṣadic sentences describe the world-regulating activity of Āditya: that in order to give all beings fruits according to their actions he governs the world through his movements of rising and setting, and that in his eternal state he exists in the form of the Supreme Self.

It should be understood that all the worlds rest on this wheel of Time. The names Saṃvatsara, Parivatsara and so on are parts of this Great Time. This Great Time is the basis of all the activities of the world. It is this that is called by various names such as Svabhāva (nature), Niyama (law) and Brahman.

किं कारणं ब्रह्म ? कुतः स्म जाता जीवानु केन क्व च संप्रतिष्ठाः । अधिष्ठिताः केन सुखेतरेषु वर्तामहे ब्रह्मविदो व्यवस्थां ॥ (*kiṃ kāraṇaṃ brahma ? kutaḥ sma jātā jīvānu kena kva ca saṃpratiṣṭhāḥ | adhiṣṭhitāḥ kena sukhetareṣu vartāmahe brahmavido vyavasthāṃ ‖*)

(Śve. U. 1-2)[?5]

What is the primal cause of the world? It is Brahman. Then what is Brahman? What is its nature? From where is our origin? Depending on what do we live? What is the support of our existence? From where do our joys and sorrows arise? In answer to such questions, the knowers of truth call the Great Time the root of all these, some calling it Niyati, some Svabhāva, some Brahman, by different names. By whatever name it is called, what is described as the wheel of Time should be understood as the primal principle. Āditya, having illumined all the worlds of the Vasus, Rudras, Ādityas and the rest, then reaches the world above them and remains there in an eternal state.

In that world Āditya has neither rising nor setting; he shines always, without a second. The Upaniṣads describe this state of Āditya's supreme station. One who knows this truth reaches that world. For him too there is no rising or setting; there is always eternal immortality (eternal happiness). Therefore it is reasonable to say that the Sun, the cause of all worldly activities, is Parabrahman. In this way, there is no doubt about the settled conclusion that the Sun or Āditya is Parabrahman, and that the Gāyatrī mantra, which celebrates this Āditya or Savitṛ, is the most excellent among all Vedic mantras.

To publish such a Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, extremely ancient, extremely profound, extremely vast and the root of all the śāstras, in simple Kannada together with a critical translation, is no easy task. Yet with the weighty purpose that through such a great work all people, scholars and laymen alike, may gain growth of knowledge and become worthy of God's grace, His Highness Śrī Jayachamarajendra Wodeyar Bahadur, G.C.B., G.C.S.I., sovereign of the throne of Karnataka, patron of Vedic learning, himself a scholar, beloved of his subjects and devoted to God, by his generous patronage encourages the publication of this work, which requires great expense; this must be called the good fortune of the multitude of the people of Karnataka. For such a generous-minded sovereign, for his family, for the princess (who bears the name of the mantra regarded as the most important of Vedic mantras, Gāyatrī), for the second princess, and for the whole multitude of the people, I pray that the Lord of all, the Veda-Puruṣa, may bestow abundantly the worldly fruits, all wealth such as long life, health and prosperity, and also spiritual knowledge, the supreme good.

Mysore,

Nandana year, Kārtika, Bahula Pañcamī, Thursday,

dated 6-11-1952.

Translator,

H. P. Venkata Rao,

Court Mahāvidvān

Om. Śrī 1. Homage to the great Lord of the Gaṇas.

Four Sanskrit verses stand at the head of the volume: वागीशाद्याः सुमनसः सर्वार्थानामुपक्रमे यं नत्वा कृतकृत्याः स्युस्तं नमामि गजाननं ॥ (*vāgīśādyāḥ sumanasaḥ sarvārthānāmupakrame yaṃ natvā kṛtakṛtyāḥ syustaṃ namāmi gajānanaṃ* ‖) यस्य निश्वसितं वेदा यो वेदेभ्योखिलं जगत् । निर्ममे तमहं वंदे विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरं ॥ (*yasya niśvasitaṃ vedā yo vedebhyokhilaṃ jagat* | *nirmame* *tamahaṃ vaṃde vidyātīrthamaheśvaraṃ* ‖) तृतीयाष्टकमध्यस्थः द्वितीयोध्याय आदरात् । व्याख्यातः सायकार्येण तृतीयो व्याकरिस्यते ॥ (*tṛtīyāṣṭakamadhyasthaḥ dvitīyodhyāya ādarāt | vyākhyātaḥ sāyakāryeṇa tṛtīyo vyākarisyate* ‖) वेदः शिवः शिवो वेदो वेदाध्यायी सदाशिवः । तस्मात्सर्वप्रयत्नेन वेदमेव सदा जपेत् ॥ (*vedaḥ śivaḥ śivo vedo vedādhyāyī sadāśivaḥ | tasmātsarvaprayatnena vedameva sadā japet* ‖)

Ṛgveda Saṃhitā with Sāyaṇa's commentary, Part 17.

Chapters 3, 4, 5 of the Third Aṣṭaka. (Sūktas 40–62 of the Third Maṇḍala and Sūktas 1–18 of the Fourth Maṇḍala.)

Third chapter of the Third Aṣṭaka.

All the sūktas of this chapter belong to the Third Maṇḍala. Since a detailed account of Viśvāmitra, the seer of the Third Maṇḍala, was written at the beginning of the previous, that is the sixteenth, part, it is unnecessary to explain it again here; nevertheless we shall say a word or two briefly.

This Viśvāmitra is one of the famous Seven Seers. In the Ṛgveda the Ṛks seen by this seer number 501 in all. About the seer Viśvāmitra, Yāska has told an ancient story in his Nirukta—

विश्वामित्र ऋषिः सुदासः वैजवनस्य पुरोहितो बभूव । विश्वामित्रः सर्वमित्रः । सर्वं संस्कृतं । सुदाः कल्याणदानः । पैजवनः पिजवनस्य पुत्रः । पिजवनः पुनः स्पर्धनीयजवो वामिश्रीभावगतिर्वा । स वित्तं गृहीत्वा विपाट्टुतुद्रोभिः संभेदमाययौ । अनुययुरितरे । स विश्वामित्रो नदीस्तुष्टाव । गाधा भवत इति । अपि द्विवदपि बहुवत् तद्यद्विदुपरिष्कात्तद्व्याख्यास्यामः ॥ (*viśvāmitra ṛṣiḥ sudāsaḥ vaijavanasya purohito babhūva | viśvāmitraḥ sarvamitraḥ | sarvaṃ saṃskṛtaṃ | sudāḥ kalyāṇadānaḥ | paijavanaḥ pijavanasya putraḥ | pijavanaḥ punaḥ spardhanīyajavo vāmiśrībhāvagatirvā | sa vittaṃ gṛhītvā vipāṭṭutudrobhiḥ saṃbhedamāyayau | anuyayuritare | sa viśvāmitro nadīstuṣṭāva | gādhā bhavata iti | api dvivadapi bahuvat tadyadviduparişkāttadvyākhyāsyāmaḥ* ‖) (Ni. 7-24)

Viśvāmitra means that this seer is a friend to all, or that all are his friends; this is the literal sense of the word Viśvāmitra. This seer was the family priest of the king named Sudās, son of Pijavana. Once, taking the wealth given by that king, he set out to go to his hermitage and came to the confluence of the rivers Vipāṭ and Śutudri (the present Beas and Sutlej in the Punjab). Some thieves, wishing to seize the wealth he carried, were following him. Learning this, Viśvāmitra tried by some means to cross these rivers lying across his way, but they were very deep with the water of the flood and he could not. Then the seer praised these rivers, asking them to lessen their water and make it easy for him to pass; this is said in Ṛ. Saṃ. sūkta 3-33 and in Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-53-9 to 11. In Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33-5 this seer Viśvāmitra declares himself the son of Kuśika.

The Rāmāyaṇa, the Bhārata and other Purāṇas say that there was enmity and jealousy between Viśvāmitra and the seer Vasiṣṭha. Support for this is found in some places in the Ṛgveda too; it will be set out on those occasions. In the story of Śunaśśepha the part of the seer Viśvāmitra is very important. This story, told at length in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, we have explained fully in the third part of the Ṛ. Saṃ. Besides, descriptions concerning Viśvāmitra occur in Vedic works such as the Aitareya Āraṇyaka, Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, Taittirīya Saṃhitā, Kāṭhaka Saṃhitā, Maitrāyaṇīya Saṃhitā, Kauṣītaki Brāhmaṇa, Pañcaviṃśa Brāhmaṇa and Jaiminīya Upaniṣad Brāhmaṇa.

Explanation of the Abbreviations

अथ, सं.	Ath. Saṃ.	Atharvaveda-saṃhitā
आप. सू.	Āp. Sū.	Āpastamba Śrauta-sūtra
आप. ध. सू	Āp. Dha. Sū.	Āpastamba Dharma-sūtra
आप. प. सू.	Āp. Pa. Sū.	Āpastamba Paribhāṣā-sūtra
आ. सू. अथवा आ.	Ā. Sū. or Ā.	Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra
उ. सू.	U. Sū.	Uṇādi-sūtra
ऋ. सं.	Ṛ. Saṃ.	Ṛgveda-saṃhitā
ऐ. आ.	Ai. Ā.	Aitareya Āraṇyaka
ऐ. उ.	Ai. U.	Aitareya Upaniṣad
ऐ. ब्रा.	Ai. Brā.	Aitareya Brāhmaṇa
छा. उ.	Chā. U.	Chāndogya Upaniṣad
जै. सू.	Jai. Sū.	Jaiminīya Pūrva-mīmāṃsā-sūtra
जै. न्या. वि.	Jai. Nyā. Vi.	Jaiminīya Nyāyamālā-vistara
ता. ब्रा.	Tā. Brā.	Tāṇḍya-mahā-brāhmaṇa
तै. आ.	Tai. Ā.	Taittirīya Āraṇyaka
तै. ब्रा.	Tai. Brā.	Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa
तै. सं.	Tai. Saṃ.	Taittirīya Saṃhitā
नि.	Ni.	Nirukta, Nighaṇṭu
पा. सू.	Pā. Sū.	Pāṇinīya Sūtra
पा. शि.	Pā. Śi.	Pāṇinīya Śikṣā
फि. अथवा फि. सू.	Phi. or Phi. Sū.	Phiṭ-sūtra
ब्र. सू.	Bra. Sū.	Brahma-sūtra
म. भा.	Ma. Bhā.	Mahābhārata
म. स्मृ.	Ma. Smṛ.	Manu-smṛti
मै. सं.	Mai. Saṃ.	Maitrāyaṇīya-saṃhitā
या. स्मृ.	Yā. Smṛ.	Yājñavalkya-smṛti
वा. सं.	Vā. Saṃ.	Vājasaneya-saṃhitā
वा. पु.	Vā. Pu.	Vāyu Purāṇa
वि. पु.	Vi. Pu.	Viṣṇu Purāṇa
वे. सू.	Ve. Sū.	Vedānta-sūtra
श. ब्रा.	Śa. Brā.	Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa
सा. सं.	Sā. Saṃ.	Sāmaveda-saṃhitā, etc.

Maṇḍala 3

ॐ

Sūkta 40 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इंद्र त्वेति नवर्चं द्वितीयं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं गायत्रमैंद्रं । तथा
> चानुक्रांतं । इंद्र त्वा गायत्रं हीति ॥ अग्निष्टोमे प्रातःसवने ब्राह्मणाच्छंसिशस्त्र इदं सूक्तं ।
> सूत्रितं च । इंद्र त्वा वृषभमुद्देवभीति तिस्रः । आ. ५–१० । इति ॥
> आद्या प्रातःसवने ब्राह्मणाच्छंसिनः प्रस्थितयाज्या । सूत्रितं च । इंद्र त्वा वृषभं
> मरुतो यस्य । आ. ५–५ । इति ।

> *iṃdra tveti navarcaṃ dvitīyaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ gāyatramaiṃdraṃ | tathā*
> *cānukrāṃtaṃ | iṃdra tvā gāyatraṃ hīti ‖ agniṣṭome prātaḥsavane brāhmaṇācchaṃsiśastra idaṃ sūktaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhamuddevabhīti tisraḥ | ā. 5-10 | iti ‖*
> *ādyā prātaḥsavane brāhmaṇācchaṃsinaḥ prasthitayājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhaṃ*
> *maruto yasya | ā. 5-5 | iti |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The second sūkta, beginning इंद्र त्वा (*iṃdra tvā*), nine Ṛks, is Vaiśvāmitra (seer Viśvāmitra), its metre Gāyatrī, its deity Indra. The Anukramaṇī agrees: इंद्र त्वा गायत्रं हीति (*iṃdra tvā gāyatraṃ hīti*). In the Agniṣṭoma, at the morning pressing, the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin recites this sūkta as his śastra. The sūtra says: इंद्र त्वा वृषभमुद्देवभीति तिस्रः (*iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhamuddevabhīti tisraḥ*) (Ā. Sū. 5-10). The first Ṛk is the prasthita-yājyā of the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin at the morning pressing; the sūtra says: इंद्र त्वा वृषभं मरुतो यस्य (*iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhaṃ maruto yasya*) (Ā. Sū. 5-5).[?6]

Anuvāda: The sūkta इंद्र त्वा (*iṃdra tvā*) is the second sūkta in the fourth anuvāka of the third maṇḍala. It has nine Ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, its deity Indra, its metre Gāyatrī. The Anukramaṇī begins इंद्र त्वा गायत्रं हि (*iṃdra tvā gāyatraṃ hi*). This sūkta is applied in the Agniṣṭoma sacrifice, in the morning-pressing rite of pressing Soma juice, to the recitation of the śastra-mantra by the priest called Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin, as explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra इंद्र त्वा वृषभमुद्देदभीति तिस्रः (*iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhamuddedabhīti tisraḥ*) (Ā. 5-10); and the first Ṛk of this sūkta is applied to the prasthita-yājyā mantra to be recited by the priest Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin at the time of the morning pressing, as explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra इंद्र त्वा वृषभं मरुतो यस्य (*iṃdra tvā vṛṣabhaṃ maruto yasya*) (Ā. 5-5).

Om. Sūkta 40. Maṇḍala 3. Anuvāka 4. Sūkta 40. Aṣṭaka 3. Adhyāya 3. Vargas 1, 2. Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 9. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: Indra. Metre: Gāyatrī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ त्वा वृष॒भं व॒यं सु॒ते सोमे॑ हवामहे ।
स पा॑हि॒ मध्वो॒ अन्ध॑सः ॥ १ ॥

> *indra tvā vṛṣabhaṃ vayaṃ sute some havāmahe |*
> *sa pāhi madhvo andhasaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । त्वा । वृषभं । वयं । सुते । सोमे । हनामहे ।
> सः । पाहि । मध्वः । अंधसः ॥ १ ॥

> *iṃdra | tvā | vṛṣabhaṃ | vayaṃ | sute | some | hanāmahe |*
> *saḥ | pāhi | madhvaḥ | aṃdhasaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंदौ स्रवति सोमरसे रमते क्रीडतीतींद्रः । यद्वा इदं सर्वं जगत्साक्षाद्दर्शयतीतींद्रः । तस्य
> संबुद्धिः । हे इंद्र वृषभं कामानां वर्षकं त्वा त्वां
> सुते ग्रावभिरभिषुते सोमे वयं हवामहे । सोमपानार्थमाह्वयामः । स त्वं
> मध्वो मदकरमंधसोऽन्नलक्षणं सोमं पाहि । पिब । इंद्रशब्दं यास्को बहुधा
> निर्विवेच । इंद्र इरां दृणातीति वेरां ददातीति वेरां दधातीति वेरां दारयतीति
> वेरां धारयतीति वेंदवे द्रवतीति वेंदौ रमत इति वेंद्धे भूतानीति वा । तद्यदेनं प्राणैः
> सम्यंधंस्तदिंद्रस्येंद्रत्वमिति । यत्र यत्र योऽर्थोऽनुगुणस्तत्र
> सोऽर्थः स्वीकार्यः । इदंदर्शनादित्योपमन्यवः । इदं ब्रह्म साक्षात्पश्यतीतींद्रः ।
> तथा चारण्यके श्रूयते । स एतमेव पुरुषं ब्रह्मततमपश्यदिदमदर्शमिती ३ ।
> तस्मादिंद्रो नामेदंद्रो ह वै नाम तमिदंद्रं संतमिंद्र इत्याचक्षते परोक्षेण परोक्षप्रिया इव हि देवाः
> । ऐ. आ. २–४–३ । इति ॥ इंद्र । इदि परमैश्वर्य इति
> धातुः । स्वमायया जगद्रूपत्वं परमैश्वर्यं । अनेनाभिप्रायेण श्रूयते ।
> इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयत इति । इंदुशब्द उपपदे रमतेरन्येभ्योऽपि
> दृश्यत इति डः । पूर्वपदस्योकारलोपः । इदि परमैश्वर्य इत्यस्मादृजेंद्राग्रेत्यादिना
> रन्प्रत्ययांतत्वेन निपातितः । एवमेतानि निर्वचनानि द्रष्टव्यानि । आमंत्रिताद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> हवामहे । हैयतेर्बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणे लटि रूपं ।
> मध्वः । मधुशब्दः फलिपाटीत्यादिनोन्प्रत्ययांतः । आगमानुशासनस्यानित्यत्वान्नु मभावः ।
> संज्ञापूर्वकस्य विधेरनित्यत्वाद्गुणाभावः । यणादेशः । अंधसः । अदेर्नुम्
> धश्चेत्यसुन् । नित्सर्वः ॥

> *iṃdau sravati somarase ramate krīḍatītīṃdraḥ | yadvā idaṃ sarvaṃ*
> *jagatsākṣāddarśayatītīṃdraḥ | tasya saṃbuddhiḥ | he iṃdra vṛṣabhaṃ*
> *kāmānāṃ varṣakaṃ tvā tvāṃ*
> *sute grāvabhirabhiṣute some vayaṃ havāmahe |*
> *somapānārthamāhvayāmaḥ | sa tvaṃ*
> *madhvo madakaramaṃdhaso 'nnalakṣaṇaṃ somaṃ pāhi | piba |*
> *iṃdraśabdaṃ yāsko bahudhā*
> *nirviveca | iṃdra irāṃ dṛṇātīti verāṃ dadātīti verāṃ dadhātīti verāṃ*
> *dārayatīti*
> *verāṃ dhārayatīti veṃdave dravatīti veṃdau ramata iti veṃdde bhūtānīti*
> *vā | tadyadenaṃ prāṇaiḥ samyaṃdhaṃstadiṃdrasyeṃdratvamiti |*
> *yatra yatra yo 'rtho 'nuguṇastatra*
> *so 'rthaḥ svīkāryaḥ | idaṃdarśanādityopamanyavaḥ | idaṃ brahma*
> *sākṣātpaśyatītīṃdraḥ |*
> *tathā cāraṇyake śrūyate | sa etameva puruṣaṃ*

> *brahmatatamapaśyadidamadarśamitī 3 |*
> *tasmādiṃdro nāmedaṃḍro ha vai nāma tamidaṃdraṃ saṃtamiṃdra*
> *ityācakṣate parokṣeṇa parokṣapriyā iva hi devāḥ | ai. ā. 2-4-3 | iti ‖*
> *iṃdra | idi paramaiśvarya iti*
> *dhātuḥ | svamāyayā jagadrūpatvaṃ paramaiśvaryaṃ |*
> *anenābhiprāyeṇa śrūyate |*
> *iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyata iti | iṃduśabda upapade*
> *ramateranyebhyo 'pi*
> *dṛśyata iti ḍaḥ | pūrvapadasyokāralopaḥ | idi paramaiśvarya*
> *ityasmādṛjeṃdrāgretyādinā ranpratyayāṃtatvena nipātitaḥ | evametāni*
> *nirvacanāni draṣṭavyāni | āmaṃtritādyudāttatvaṃ | havāmahe |*
> *haiyaterbahulaṃ chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe laṭi rūpaṃ |*
> *madhvaḥ | madhuśabdaḥ phalipāṭīityādinonpratyayāṃtaḥ |*
> *āgamānuśāsanasyānityatvānnu mabhāvaḥ | saṃjñāpūrvakasya*
> *vidheranityatvādduṇābhāvaḥ | yaṇādeśaḥ | aṃdhasaḥ | adernum*
> *dhaścetyasun | nitsarvaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Indra" is so called because he delights and sports in the Soma juice flowing in the drop (indu); or else because he shows this whole world directly. The word is a vocative: O Indra, showerer of desires, we call you at the Soma pressed with the stones, to drink Soma; do you drink the intoxicating Soma, which is of the nature of food (andhas). Yāska explained the word Indra in many ways: he gives, splits, bears, or has the earth bear food (irā); or he runs to the drop; or he delights in the drop; or beings kindle him with their breaths, and that is Indra's Indra-hood. Whichever sense suits a place is to be accepted there. Upamanyu's school says इदंदर्शनादित्योपमन्यवः (*idaṃdarśanādityopamanyavaḥ*): he sees this Brahman directly. So it is heard in the Āraṇyaka: स एतमेव पुरुषं ब्रह्मततमपश्यदिदमदर्शमिती ३ । तस्मादिंद्रो नामेदंड्रो ह वै नाम तमिदंद्रं संतमिंद्र इत्याचक्षते परोक्षेण परोक्षप्रिया इव हि देवाः । (*sa etameva puruṣaṃ brahmatatamapaśyadidamadarśamitī 3 | tasmādiṃdro nāmedaṃḍro ha vai nāma tamidaṃdraṃ saṃtamiṃdra ityācakṣate parokṣeṇa parokṣapriyā iva hi devāḥ* |) (Ai. Ā. 2-4-3); that is, he saw this Person, the all-pervading Brahman, and said "I have seen this"; therefore the name is Indra, and the gods love the hidden.

The root इदि (*idi*) has the sense of supreme lordship; supreme lordship is taking the form of the world by his own māyā. With this idea it is heard: इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते (*iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate*). Thus these etymologies are to be understood. The remainder is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—showerer of desires
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- सोमे सुते (*some sute*)—because the Soma juice has been pressed and made ready
- हवामहे (*havāmahe*)—we pray and call
- सः (*saḥ*)—such (glorious) you
- मध्वः (*madhvaḥ*)—of sweet juice
- अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*)—the Soma juice, called food
- पाहिं (*pāhiṃ*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, since we have pressed the Soma juice and made it ready, we pray and call you, the showerer of desires. Do you, of great glory, drink this Soma juice, sweet and called food.

English translation

We invoke you, Indra, showerer (of benefits), to the effused libation: do you drink of the exhilarating beverage.

Special Topics

Indra—The commentator explains the etymology of the word Indra thus: इंदौ स्रवति सोमरसे रमते क्रीडतीतींद्रः (*iṃdau sravati somarase ramate krīḍatītīṃdraḥ*). When the Soma plants are crushed and the juice pressed out, Indra, seeing the drops of Soma juice oozing and dripping, dances with joy; hence the name Indra. Or: यद्वा इदं सर्वं

जगत्साक्षाद्दर्शयतीतींद्रः (*yadvā idaṃ sarvaṃ jagatsākṣāddarśayatītīṃdraḥ*). Because he shows this whole world directly, the name Indra is fitting for him.

Besides, Yāska has given the etymology of the word Indra in many ways—

इंद्र इरां दृणातीति वेरां ददातीति वेरां दधातीति वेरां दारयतीति वेरां धारयतीति नेंदने द्रवतीति वेंदौ रमत इति वेंधे भूतानीति वा तद्यदेनं प्राणैः सम्यंधंस्तदिंद्रस्येंद्रत्वमिति विज्ञायत इदंकरणादित्याग्रायण इदंदर्शनादित्योपमन्यव इंदतेर्वैश्वर्यकर्मण इञ्छत्रोणां दारयिता वा द्रावयिता वादरयिता च यज्वनां । (*iṃdra irāṃ dṛṇātīti verāṃ dadātīti verāṃ dadhātīti verāṃ dārayatīti verāṃ dhārayatīti neṃdane dravatīti veṃdau ramata iti veṃdhe bhūtānīti vā tadyadenaṃ prāṇaiḥ samyaṃdhaṃstadiṃdrasyeṃdratvamiti vijñāyata idaṃkaraṇādityāgrāyaṇa idaṃdarśanādityopamanyava iṃdatervaiśvaryakarmaṇa iñchatroṇāṃ dārayitā vā drāvayitā vādarayitā ca yajvanāṃ |*) (Ni. 10-8). He himself has given the sense of this.

1. दृ विदारण इति धातुः । इरामन्नमुद्धिश्य तन्निष्टादकजलसिध्यर्थं दृणाति मेघं विदीर्णं करोतीतींद्रः (*dṛ vidāraṇa iti dhātuḥ | irāmannamuddhiśya tanniṣṭādakajalasidhyarthaṃ dṛṇāti meghaṃ vidīrṇaṃ karotītīṃdraḥ*)—The root dṛ means to split, to cut. Irā means food. Food comes to us from herbs and trees, that is, from the plant world. For that plant world to grow, water is necessary. For that water, that is, for rain to fall, he cuts the cloud (with lightning, the thunderbolt); therefore the name Indra.
2. डुदाञ् दान इति धातुः । इरामन्नं वृष्टनिष्पादनेन ददातीतींद्रः ॥ (*ḍudāñ dāna iti dhātuḥ | irāmannaṃ vṛṣṭaniṣpādanena dadātītīṃdraḥ ‖*)—The root dā means to give. He gives irā, food, by means of vṛṣṭi (rain); therefore the name Indra.
3. धाञ् पोषणार्थः । इरामन्नं तृप्ति कारणं सस्यं दधाति जलप्रदानेन पुष्पातीतींद्रः ॥ (*dhāñ poṣaṇārthaḥ | irāmannaṃ tṛpti kāraṇaṃ sasyaṃ dadhāti jalapradānena puṣpātītīṃdraḥ ‖*)—The root dhā means to nourish. He nourishes with the gift of water (rain) the plants and the like that give food; therefore the name Indra.

4. इरामुत्पादयितुं कर्षकमुखेन भूमिं विदारयतीतींद्रः । (*irāmutpādayituṃ karṣakamukhena bhūmiṃ vidārayatītīṃdraḥ* |)—To produce food the earth must be ploughed. When the earth is ploughed, he makes it split with the plough and so makes it favourable to the crop; therefore the name Indra.

5. पूर्वोक्त पोषणमुखेनेरां धारयति विनाशराहित्येन स्थापयतीतींद्रः । (*pūrvokta poṣaṇamukhenerāṃ dhārayati vināśarāhityena sthāpayatītīṃdraḥ* |)—As said before, he nourishes the plants and the like and protects them so that they do not perish; therefore the name Indra.

6. इंदुः सोमो वल्लीरसः । तदर्थं यागभूमौ द्रवति धावतीतींद्रः (*iṃduḥ somo vallīrasaḥ | tadarthaṃ yāgabhūmau dravati dhāvatītīṃdraḥ*)—Indu means the Soma juice prepared from the Soma plant. He runs (hastens) to the place of sacrifice for the drinking of such Soma; therefore the name Indra.

7. इंदौ यथोक्ते सोमे रमते क्रीडतीतींद्रः । (*iṃdau yathokte some ramate krīḍatītīṃdraḥ* |)—Satisfied with the Soma juice mentioned before, he moves about at ease; therefore the name Indra.

8. इांइंधी दीप्ताविति धातुः । भूतानि प्राणिदेहानिंदे जीवचैतन्यरूपेणांतःप्रविश्य दीपयतीतींद्रः ॥ (*iāṃiṃdhī dīptāviti dhātuḥ* | *bhūtāni prāṇidehāniṃde jīvacaitanyarūpeṇāṃtaḥpraviśya dīpayatītīṃdraḥ* ‖)[?7] The root indh means to shine, to illumine. Entering the bodies of living beings in the form of the life-force, and shining while impelling them to do their respective acts; therefore the name Indra.

9. यद्यस्मात्कारणादेनं परमात्मरूपमिंद्रं देवं प्राणैर्वाक्चक्षुरादींद्रियैः प्राणापानादिवायुभिश्च सहितं सम्मैंधन्नु पासका ध्यानेन सम्यक्रकाशितवंतस्तत्तस्मात्कारणादिंद्रनाम संपन्नं । (*yadyasmātkāraṇādenaṃ paramātmarūpamiṃdraṃ devaṃ prāṇairvākcakṣurādīṃdriyaiḥ prāṇāpānādivāyubhiśca sahitaṃ sammaiṃdhannu pāsakā dhyānena samyakrakāśitavaṃtastattasmātkāraṇādiṃdranāma saṃpannaṃ* |)[?8] Because worshippers, joining this god of the form of the Supreme Self with the sense organs such as speech

and sight and with the vital airs such as prāṇa and apāna, conceive him in meditation as shining brightly; hence the name Indra.

10. आग्रायणनामको मुनिरिदंकरणादिंद्र इति निर्वचनं मन्यते । इंद्रो हि परमात्मरूपेणेदं जगत्करोति (*āgrāyaṇanāmako muniridaṃkaraṇādiṃdra iti nirvacanaṃ manyate | iṃdro hi paramātmarūpeṇedaṃ jagatkaroti*)—Idaṅkaraṇa means that Indra, in the form of the Supreme Self, makes (creates) this world; hence the name Indra came to this god, says the sage named Āgrāyaṇa.

11. औपम्यनवनामको मुनिरिदंदर्शनादिंद्र इति निर्वचनवाह । इदमित्यापरोक्ष्यमुच्यते । (*aupamyanavanāmako muniridaṃdarśanādiṃdra iti nirvacanavāha | idamityāparokṣyamucyate |*)[?9]—The sage Aupamanyava says that because he sees this, that is, everything, the name Indra arose. Here "this" means the imperceptible, what does not appear visibly to the eye. For that very reason the Śruti says परोक्षप्रिया इव हि देवाः (*parokṣapriyā iva hi devāḥ*).

12. इवि परमैश्वर्य इति धातुः । स्वमायेया जगद्रूपत्वं परमैश्वर्यं । तद्योगादिंद्रः । (*ivi paramaiśvarya iti dhātuḥ | svamāyèyā jagadrūpatvaṃ paramaiśvaryaṃ | tadyogādiṃdraḥ |*)—The root idi has the sense of supreme lordship. This god has the supreme lordship of taking the form of the world by his own māyā; hence the name Indra. This idea is supported by the Vedic sentence इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते (*iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-18).

13. इनशब्दस्येश्वरवाचकस्याकारलोपे सति नकारांतमिन्निति पदं भवति । द्य भय इति धातुः । स च परमेश्वरः शत्रूणां दारयिता भीषयितेतींद्रः ॥ (*inaśabdasyeśvaravācakasyākāralope sati nakārāṃtaminniti padaṃ bhavati | dya bhaya iti dhātuḥ | sa ca parameśvaraḥ śatrūṇāṃ dārayitā bhīṣayitetīṃdraḥ ||*)—The word ina denotes the Lord. If the vowel a over the n of this word ina is dropped, the word in remains. The root dṛ[?10] means fear. That god, the Supreme Lord, causes fear to enemies; hence the name Indra.

14. द्रु गताविति धातुः । शत्रूणां द्रावयिता पलायनं प्रापयितेतींद्रः ॥ (*dru gatāviti dhātuḥ | śatrūṇāṃ drāvayitā palāyanaṃ prāpayitetīṃdraḥ ‖*)—The root dru has the sense of going, that is, go, run away. This god makes enemies run away; hence the name Indra.
15. यज्ञनां यागानुष्ठायिनामादरयिता भयस्य परिहर्ता (*yajñanāṃ yāgānuṣṭhāyināmādarayitā bhayasya parihartā*)—He honours those who worship him with sacrifices and the like, and removes their fear; hence the name Indra for this god. In the same way many etymologies can be devised for the word Indra.

Besides these meanings, the commentator says that in each context whichever meaning suits Indra should be accepted there. For example: इदं दर्शनादित्यौवमन्यवः । इदं ब्रह्म साक्षात्पश्यतीतींद्रः । (*idaṃ darśanādityauvamanyavaḥ | idaṃ brahma sākṣātpaśyatītīṃdraḥ |*) And in the Āraṇyaka it is heard: स एतमेव पुरुषं ब्रह्मततममपश्यदिदमदर्शमिती ३ । तस्मादिंद्रो नामेदंद्रो ह वै नाम तमिदंद्रं संतमिंद्र इत्याचक्षते परोक्षेण परोक्षप्रिया इव हि देवाः (*sa etameva puruṣaṃ brahmatatamamapaśyadidamadarśamitī 3 | tasmādiṃdro nāmedaṃdro ha vai nāma tamidaṃdraṃ saṃtamiṃdra ityācakṣate parokṣeṇa parokṣapriyā iva hi devāḥ*) (Ai. Ā. 2-4-3).

Here the word इदं (*idaṃ*) denotes Brahman. Since Indra sees that Brahman directly, that is, is able to see it, he is named Indra. After explaining the meaning in this way, the commentator quoted the Aitareya Āraṇyaka passage above, from स एतमेव (*sa etameva*) to इव हि देवाः (*iva hi devāḥ*), in support of it.

वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—This word is formed from the root वृषु वर्षणे (*vṛṣu varṣaṇe*). It means one who pours down the desired objects of those who serve him, as rain pours down. The word is generally used of Indra.

सोमे सुते (*some sute*)—ग्रावभिरभिषुते सोमे (*grāvabhirabhiṣute some*): in the Soma pressed with the stones. The meaning is: after the Soma plants have been crushed with stones, the juice squeezed out, and the juice strained and made ready, fit for drinking. I have explained the method of preparing the Soma juice at length many times before; see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 10, pages 631, 637 and 697. For Indra's drinking of Soma, see Part 14, page 606.

मध्वः अंधसः (*madhvaḥ aṃdhasaḥ*)—मदकरमंधसोऽन्नलक्षणं सोमं (*madakaramaṃdhaso 'nnalakṣaṇaṃ somaṃ*). The word मध्वः (*madhvaḥ*) is an adjective of the word अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*). It may be given the meanings sweet, tasty, delightful, causing intoxication or joy. The word अंध (*aṃdha*) is read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9). Besides, Yāska says of the word अंधस् (*aṃdhas*): अंध इत्यन्ननामाध्यानीयं भवति । तमोऽप्यंध उच्यते नास्मिन् ध्यानं भवति । न दर्शनमंधंतम इत्यभिभाषंते । अयमपीतरोऽन्न एतस्मादेव । पश्यदक्षण्वान्न विचेतदंध इत्यपि निगमो भवति ॥ (*aṃdha ityannanāmādhyānīyaṃ bhavati | tamo 'pyaṃdha ucyate nāsmin dhyānaṃ bhavati | na darśanamaṃdhaṃtama ityabhibhāṣaṃte | ayamapītaro 'nna etasmādeva | paśyadakṣaṇvānna vicetadaṃdha ityapi nigamo bhavati ‖*) (Ni. 5-1).

That is, the word अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*) is a name for food. Why? Because food is needed by everyone, it is prayed for (desired) by everyone; therefore अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*) means food. Also in connection with Soma

juice, the use of the word अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*) in the sense of the Soma juice, which is of the nature of food, is especially frequent in the Ṛgveda. अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*) is also a name for darkness (tamas). For in darkness nothing is seen, so nothing can be done. Even in worldly usage, people say अंधंतम (*aṃdhaṃtama*) when darkness has fallen so that nothing can be seen by the eye. He says that there is also an example of this in the Vedic text पश्यदक्षण्वान्न उचेतदंधः (*paśyadakṣaṇvānna ucetadaṃdhaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-16).

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ क्र॒तु॒विदं॑ सु॒तं सोमं॑ हर्य पुरुष्टुत ।
पिबा वृं॑षस्व॒ तातृं॑पिम् ॥ २ ॥

> *indra kratuvidaṃ sutaṃ somaṃ harya puruṣṭuta |*
> *pibā vṛṣasva tātṛpim ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । क्रत्युविदं । सुतं । सोमं । हर्य । पुरुस्तुत ।
> पिब । आ । वृषस्व । ततृसिं ॥ २ ॥

> *iṃdra | kratyuvidaṃ | sutaṃ | somaṃ | harya | purustuta |*
> *piba | ā | vṛṣasva | tatṛsiṃ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ब्राह्मणाच्छंसिनः प्रातःसवन इंद्र क्रतुविदमिति शस्त्रयाज्या । सूत्रितं च ।
> इंद्र क्रतुविदं सुतमिति याज्या । आ. ५–१० । इति ॥
> हे इंद्र क्रतुविदं क्रतोः प्रज्ञाया लंभकं सुतमभिषुतमिमं सोमं
> हर्य । पातुं कामयस्व । हे पुरुष्टुत पुरुभिर्बहुभिः स्तुतेंद्र तातृपिं तर्पकमास्यायनकारिणिममं
> सोमं पिब । पीतमिमं सोममा वृषस्व । जठरे सिंच ।
> यथा नाभेरधो न पतति तथा धारयेति भावः ॥ हर्य । हर्य गतिकांत्योरित्यस्य
> लोटि रूपं । निघातः । पुरुष्टुत । स्तुतस्तोमयोश्चंदसीति संहितायां षत्वं ।
> वृषस्व । वृष सेचन इत्यस्य लोटि रूपं । आण उत्तरत्वान्निघातः । तातृपिं । तृप
> प्रीणन इत्यस्माच्छंदसि सदादिभ्यो दर्शनादिति किन् । तस्य लिड्वद्भावाद्दिर्वचनादि ।
> संहितायामन्येषामपीत्यभ्यासस्य दीर्घः । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *brāhmaṇācchaṃsinaḥ prātaḥsavana iṃdra kratuvidamiti śastrayājyā | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *iṃdra kratuvidaṃ sutamiti yājyā | ā. 5-10 | iti ‖*
> *he iṃdra kratuvidaṃ kratoḥ prajñāyā laṃbhakaṃ sutamabhiṣutamimaṃ somaṃ*
> *harya | pātuṃ kāmayasva | he puruṣṭuta purubhirbahubhiḥ stuteṃdra tātṛpiṃ tarpakamāsyāyanakāriṇimamaṃ somaṃ piba | pītamimaṃ somamā vṛṣasva | jaṭhare siṃca |*
> *yathā nābheradho na patati tathā dhārayeti bhāvaḥ ‖ harya | harya gatikāṃtyorityasya*
> *loṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | puruṣṭuta | stutastomayośca ṃdasīti saṃhitāyāṃ ṣatvaṃ |*
> *vṛṣasva | vṛṣa secana ityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | āṇa uttaratvānnighātaḥ | tātṛpiṃ | tṛpa*
> *prīṇana ityasmācchaṃdasi sadādibhyo darśanāditi kin | tasya liḍvadbhāvāddirvacanādi |*
> *saṃhitāyāmanyeṣāmapītyabhyāsasya dīrghaḥ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

For the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin priest at the morning pressing, this verse इंद्र क्रतुविदं (*iṃdra kratuvidaṃ*) is the śastra-yājyā; and it is prescribed in the sūtra इंद्र क्रतुविदं सुतमिति याज्या (*iṃdra kratuvidaṃ sutamiti yājyā*) (Ā. 5-10). "O Indra, desire to drink this pressed Soma, the obtainer of kratu, that is, of wisdom (prajñā). O Indra, praised by many, drink this Soma, which satisfies and refreshes. Having drunk it, pour it into the belly; the sense is: hold it so that it does not fall below the navel."

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)—praised by many
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- क्रतुविदं (*kratuvidaṃ*)—the giver of wisdom
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma juice
- हर्य (*harya*)—desire to drink
- तातृपिं (*tātṛpiṃ*)—this Soma, which gives satisfaction
- पिब (*piba*)—drink
- आ वृषस्व (*ā vṛṣasva*)—pour it into the belly

Gist

O Indra, praised by many, desire to drink the Soma juice, which gives wisdom and is ready, pressed. Drink this satisfying juice and fill your belly.

English translation

Indra, the praised of many, accept the effused Soma juice, the conferrer of knowledge ; drink ; imbibe the satisfactory draught.

Special Topics

At the morning pressing the priest called Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin is to use this verse इंद्र क्रतुविदं (*iṃdra kratuvidaṃ*) as a śastra-yājyā mantra; this is stated by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra इंद्र क्रतुविदं सुतमिति याज्या (*iṃdra kratuvidaṃ sutamiti yājyā*).

क्रतुविदं (*kratuvidaṃ*)—For the word क्रतु (*kratu*) Yāska gave the explanation क्रतुं कर्म वा प्रज्ञां ना (*kratuṃ karma vā prajñāṃ nā*) (Ni. 2-28). Moreover the word क्रतु (*kratu*) is read among the twenty-six names of action beginning with अपः (*apaḥ*) and अष्टः (*aṣṭaḥ*) (Ni. 3-1), and among the eleven names of wisdom beginning with केतः (*ketaḥ*) and केतुः (*ketuḥ*) (Ni. 3-13). Therefore क्रतुविदं (*kratuvidaṃ*) means प्रज्ञया लंभकं (*prajñayā laṃbhakaṃ*): that which can be obtained by wisdom, by knowledge. The meaning is that proper understanding or knowledge is needed to prepare the Soma juice. Or, if the word क्रतु (*kratu*) is taken to mean action, it may mean the Soma juice prepared in the sacrificial action. The sense is: such a Soma juice.

सुतं सोमं (*sutaṃ somaṃ*)—The use of the word सुतं (*sutaṃ*) here means the Soma juice that has just now, in this sacrifice, been freshly prepared: the Soma plants crushed, the juice squeezed out, strained and made ready, fit for drinking.

पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)—पुरुभिर्बहुभिः स्तुतेंद्र (*purubhirbahubhiḥ stuteṃdra*): Indra, who is praised by many people. Many people, priests, sacrificers and others, praise Indra.

पिब (*piba*)—The final syllable of this word is made long in the Saṃhitā text for the convenience of the metre. Such usage is frequent in the Ṛgveda. For example, the word पिब (*piba*) in पिबा सोममभि (*pibā somamabhi*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-17-1); पिबा सोममिंद्र मंदतु (*pibā somamiṃdra maṃdatu*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-22-1); पिबा सोमं मदाय (*pibā somaṃ madāya*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-95-3); पिबा सोमं महते (*pibā somaṃ mahate*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-116-1); the verse?[11]

The word श्रुधि (*śrudhi*) too is used with a long final syllable in verses such as श्रुधी नो अग्ने सदने (*śrudhī no agne sadane*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-11-9), श्रुधी न इंद्र (*śrudhī na iṃdra*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-26-1), श्रुधी हवमिंद्र शूर (*śrudhī havamiṃdra śūra*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-148-5), श्रुधी हवं तिरश्चाशि (*śrudhī havaṃ tiraścāśi*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-95-4), and so on. There are many such examples.

तातृपिं (*tātṛpiṃ*)—तर्पकमाप्यायनकारिणमिमं सोमं (*tarpakamāpyāyanakāriṇamimaṃ somaṃ*): the Soma that causes satisfaction; that is, the Soma juice which, after being drunk, settles in the belly, cools it and makes joy arise. There are many descriptions that drinking Soma juice produces satisfaction or joy and also intoxication.

वृषस्व (*vṛṣasva*)—जठरे सिंच । यथा नाभेरधो न पतति तथा धारयेति भावः । (*jaṭhare siṃca | yathā nābheradho na patati tathā dhārayeti bhāvaḥ |*) In this verse it is plainly said पिब (*piba*), "drink the Soma juice"; is not the use of the word वृषस्व (*vṛṣasva*) then useless? The answer: since Indra is famous as extremely fond of drinking Soma juice, the use of the two words पिब (*piba*) and वृषभ (*vṛṣabha*)[?12] is also proper, to stress plainly: "when drinking Soma, drink as much as you wish, so that it does not fall below the navel, and drink so that the inner part of the belly is well soaked and refreshed."

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ प्र णो॑ धि॒तावा॑नं य॒ज्ञं विश्वे॑भिर्दे॒वेभि॑ः ।
ति॒र स्त॑वान विश्पते ॥ ३ ॥

> *indra pra ṇo dhitāvānaṃ yajñaṃ viśvebhirdevebhiḥ |*
> *tira stavāna viśpate ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । प्र । नः । धितवानं । यज्ञं । विश्वेभिः । देवेभिः ।
> तिरः । स्तवान । विश्वते ॥ ३ ॥

> *iṃdra | pra | naḥ | dhitavānaṃ | yajñaṃ | viśvebhiḥ | devebhiḥ |*
> *tiraḥ | stavāna | viśvate ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे स्तवान स्तोतृभिः स्तूयमान विश्वते विशां मरुतां पते हे इंद्र विश्वेभिर्देवेभिः सर्वैर्यजनीयैर्देवैः सहितस्तं धितावानं । वन्यते संभज्यत इति
> वानं हविः । धितं निहितं हविर्यस्य तं । संभृतहविष्कमित्यर्थः । अस्मदीयमिमं
> यज्ञं प्र तिरः । प्रकर्षेण वर्धय । हविःस्वीकरणेन संपूर्णं कुर्विति भावः ॥ णः ।

> *he stavāna stotṛbhiḥ stūyamāna viśvate viśāṃ marutāṃ pate he iṃdra viśvebhirdevebhiḥ sarvairyajanīyairdevaiḥ sahitastaṃ dhitāvānaṃ |*
> *vanyate saṃbhajyata iti*
> *vānaṃ haviḥ | dhitaṃ nihitaṃ haviryasya taṃ |*
> *saṃbhṛtahaviṣkamityarthaḥ | asmadīyamimaṃ*
> *yajñaṃ pra tiraḥ | prakarṣeṇa vardhaya | haviḥsvīkaraṇena saṃpūrṇaṃ kurviti bhāvaḥ ‖ ṇaḥ |*

> उपसर्गाद्बहुलमिति संहितायां णत्वं । धितावानं । डुधाण् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्मान्निष्ठा ।
> बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । तिरः । तरतेर्व्यत्ययेन शः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ।
> स्तवान । ष्टुञ् स्तुत् । सम्यानच् स्तुव इत्युपपदाभावेऽपि कर्मण्यानच् प्रत्ययः ।
> आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः ॥

> *upasargādbahulamiti saṃhitāyāṃ ṇatvaṃ | dhitāvānaṃ | ḍudhāṇ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasmānniṣṭhā | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ |*
> *tiraḥ | taratervyatyayena śaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *stavāna | ṣṭuñ stut | samyānac stuva ityupapadābhāve 'pi karmaṇyānac pratyayaḥ |*
> *āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, praised by singers (स्तवान (*stavāna*)), lord of the विश् (*viś*), that is, of the Maruts (विश्वते (*viśvate*)): together with all the gods worthy of sacrifice, प्र तिरः (*pra tiraḥ*), make grow vigorously this sacrifice of ours, which is धितावानं (*dhitāvānaṃ*)." वानं (*vānaṃ*) is the oblation, because it is shared out (वन्यते संभज्यते (*vanyate saṃbhajyate*)); धितं (*dhitaṃ*) means placed; so the sacrifice is one in which the oblation has been placed, that is, in which the oblation has been gathered. "Make it grow" means: complete it by accepting the oblation.

Word-to-word meaning

- स्तवान (*stavāna*)—he who is praised (by the devotees)
- विश्वते (*viśvate*)—lord of the Maruts, who are of the nature of subjects
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- विश्वेभिः देवेभिः (*viśvebhiḥ devebhiḥ*)—together with all the gods

- धितावानं (*dhitāvānaṃ*)—furnished with oblation
- नः यज्ञं (*naḥ yajñaṃ*)—this sacrifice of ours
- प्रतिर (*pratira*)—make it grow

Gist

O Indra, who are praised by the devotees and are lord of the Maruts, who are of the nature of subjects, together with all the gods make this sacrifice of ours, furnished with oblation, grow.

English translation

Indra, lord of men, you are praised (by the devout) and aided by the gods ; perfect this our sacrifice in which the oblation is offered (to you).

Special Topics

विश्वते (*viśvate*)—विशां मरुतां पते (*viśāṃ marutāṃ pate*): Indra, the leader of the Marut gods. There is a very important companionship between the Marut gods and Indra. We have explained this at length in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 8, page 172, and Part 13, page 210.

The eternal companionship of Indra and the Maruts is well known from the Śruti. The relation of king and subjects between Indra and the Maruts, the offering of oblations to Indra together with the Maruts in the principal sacrificial acts, and the Maruts' helping Indra when he fights with the demon Vṛtra, are described in many places in the Saṃhitās and the Brāhmaṇas.

क्षत्रं वा इंद्रो विशो मरुतो विशा वै क्षत्रियो बलवान् भवति ॥ (*kṣatraṃ vā iṃdro viśo maruto viśā vai kṣatriyo balavān bhavati* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-3-6).

Indra is the king of kṣatriya splendour, the Maruts are the subjects; it is indicated here that the king becomes powerful only through the support of the subjects, and that through the help of the Maruts Indra's valour increased.

मरुद्भिः सह यत्रेंद्रो मरुत्वांस्तत्र सोऽभवत् । (*maruddiḥ saha yatreṃdro marutvāṃstatra so 'bhavat* |) (Bṛ. De. 4-56).

The Bṛhaddevatā explains this adjective, which indicates the relation of these deities: wherever Indra together with the Maruts is addressed, he is called मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*).

धितानानं (*dhitānānaṃ*)—वन्यते संभज्यते इति वानं हविः । धितं निहितं हविर्यस्य तं । संभृतहविष्यमित्यर्थः । (*vanyate saṃbhajyate iti vānaṃ haviḥ | dhitaṃ nihitaṃ haviryasya taṃ | saṃbhṛtahaviṣyamityarthaḥ |*) The word वानं (*vānaṃ*), formed from the root वन षण संभक्तौ (*vana ṣaṇa saṃbhaktau*), means a thing prepared. The sense is: the action, that is, the sacrifice, in which such a thing, that is, an oblation, has been set down to be offered to the gods. In the sacrifice the oblation is prepared and kept ready to offer to the gods. The meaning of the word is: a sacrifice furnished with such an oblation.

प्रति (*prati*)—Accept the oblation we offer and make this sacrifice grow, make it complete.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ सोमा॑ः सु॒ता इ॒मे तव॒ प्र य॑न्ति सत्पते ।
क्षयं॑ च॒न्द्रास॒ इन्द॑वः ॥ ४ ॥

> *indra somāḥ sutā ime tava pra yanti satpate |*
> *kṣayaṃ candrāsa indavaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । सोमाः । सुताः । इमे । तव । प्र । यंति । सत्पते ।
> क्षयं । चंद्रासः । इंदवः ॥ ४ ॥

> *iṃdra | somāḥ | sutāḥ | ime | tava | pra | yaṃti | satpate |*
> *kṣayaṃ | caṃdrāsaḥ | iṃdavaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे सत्पते इंद्र चंद्रास आह्लादयितार इंदवो दीप्ताः सुता अभिषुता
> इमेऽस्माभिर्दत्ताः सोमाः क्षयं । क्षियंति निवसंत्यन्नादीन्यत्रेति क्षयो जठरं ।
> प्र यंति । प्रकर्षण गच्छंति । तान् धारयेति भावः ॥ क्षयं । क्षि निवासगत्योरित्यस्मादधिकरणे

> घप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरेणांतोदात्ते प्राप्ते क्षयो निवास इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं । चंद्रासः । चदि
> आह्लादने दीप्ता च । अस्मात्सा यितंचीत्यादिना रक्षत्ययः । आज्ञसेरसुगित्यसुक् ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । इंदवः । उंदेरिच्चा देरित्युप्रत्ययः ।
> निदित्यनुवृत्तेराद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he satpate iṃdra caṃdrāsa āhlādayitāra iṃdavo dīptāḥ sutā abhiṣutā*
> *ime 'smābhirdattāḥ somāḥ kṣayaṃ | kṣiyaṃti nivasaṃtyannādīnyatreti*
> *kṣayo jaṭharaṃ |*
> *pra yaṃti | prakarṣaṇa gacchaṃti | tān dhārayeti bhāvaḥ || kṣayaṃ | kṣi*
> *nivāsagatyorityasmādadhikaraṇe ghapratyayaḥ |*
> *pratyayasvareṇāṃtodātte prāpte kṣayo nivāsa ityādyudāttatvaṃ |*
> *caṃdrāsaḥ | cadi āhlādane dīptā ca | asmātsā yitaṃcītyādinā*
> *rakṣatyayaḥ | ājñaserasugityasuk | pratyayasvaraḥ | iṃdavaḥ |*
> *uṃdericcā derityupratyayaḥ |*
> *nidityanuvṛtterādyudāttaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Indra, lord of the good (सत्पते (*satpate*)): these Soma juices, gladdening (चंद्रासः (*caṃdrāsaḥ*)) and bright (इंदवः (*iṃdavaḥ*)), pressed and offered by us, go forth (प्र यंति (*pra yaṃti*)) into क्षयं (*kṣayaṃ*)." क्षय (*kṣaya*) is the belly, since food and the like dwell (क्षियंति (*kṣiyaṃti*)) in it; प्र यंति (*pra yaṃti*) means they go forth vigorously. The sense is: hold them. चंद्रासः (*caṃdrāsaḥ*) is from चदि (*cadi*), in the sense of gladdening and shining.

Word-to-word meaning

- सत्पते (*satpate*)—O lord of the virtuous
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—Indra
- चंद्रासः (*caṃdrāsaḥ*)—delighting
- इंदवः (*iṃdavaḥ*)—brilliant
- सुताः (*sutāḥ*)—pressed
- इमे (*ime*)—offered by us
- सोमाः (*somāḥ*)—these Soma juices
- तव (*tava*)—your
- क्षयं (*kṣayaṃ*)—towards the dwelling-place in the form of the stomach

- प्र यंति (*pra yaṃti*)—flow forth (in streams)

Gist

O Indra, protector of the virtuous, these Soma juices, delighting, brilliant, pressed and offered by us, flow towards your dwelling-place, your stomach.

English translation

Indra, lord of the virtuous, these effused Soma juices, exhilarating and brilliant, proceed to your abode (stomach)

Special Topics

चंद्रासः (*caṃdrāsaḥ*)—The word चंद्र (*caṃdra*), formed from the root चदि आह्लादने (*cadi āhlādane*), means delightful, giving joy. This word is an adjective of the word सोमाः (*somāḥ*).

इंदवः (*iṃdavaḥ*)—The word इंदु (*iṃdu*), formed from the root उंदी क्लेदने (*uṃdī kledane*), means oozing, dripping. When the Soma plants are crushed with a stone and the juice is taken out, the Soma juice drips little by little, just as juice oozes when sugarcane is pressed; so it is the custom to call freshly pressed Soma juice इंदु (*iṃdu*) or इंदवः (*iṃdavaḥ*) (plural). Since it has just been pressed, the sense "shining" can also be given.

क्षयं (*kṣayaṃ*)—The dwelling-place. Here the dwelling-place means Indra's belly. After Indra drinks the Soma juice it goes into his belly and settles there; hence that stomach is designated here as क्षयं (*kṣayaṃ*), the dwelling-place.

इमे सुताः (*ime sutāḥ*)—These Soma juices that we are pressing now in the sacrifice; that is, not juices pressed earlier. The sense is: the Soma juice freshly pressed now.

सोमाः सुताः (*somāḥ sutāḥ*)—These are words ending in the nominative plural. The earlier forms of these words, सोमासः सुतासः (*somāsaḥ sutāsaḥ*), are also much used in the Ṛgveda.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

द॒धि॒ष्वा ज॒ठरे॑ सु॒तं सोम॑मिन्द्र॒ वरे॑ण्यम् ।
तव॑ द्यु॒क्षास॒ इन्द॑वः ॥ ५ ॥

> *dadhiṣvā jaṭhare sutaṃ somamindra vareṇyam |*
> *tava dyukṣāsa indavaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> दधिष्व । जठरे । सुतं । सोमं । इंद्र । वरेण्यं ।
> तप । म्यक्षासक । इंदवः ॥ ५ ॥

> *dadhiṣva | jaṭhare | sutaṃ | somaṃ | iṃdra | vareṇyaṃ |*
> *tapa | myakṣāsaka | iṃdavaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वरेण्यं सर्वैर्वर्णीयं सुतमभिषुतं सोमं जठरे दधिष्क
> धारय । इंदवो दीप्ता इमे सोमास्तव द्युक्षासः । दिवि क्षियंति निवसंतीति
> द्युक्षासः । अतस्त्वं तान् धारयेति भावः ॥ दधिष्क । दधातेर्लोटि रूपं । आगमा
> अनुदात्ता इतीटोऽनुदात्तत्वात्पत्ययस्वरः वरेण्यं । वृज् संभक्तौ । वृज एण्य।
> इत्येण्प्रत्ययः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः । द्युक्षासः । क्षियतेरन्येभ्योऽपि दृश्यत इति
> डप्रत्ययः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra vareṇyaṃ sarvairvarṇīyaṃ sutamabhiṣutaṃ somaṃ jaṭhare dadhiṣka*
> *dhāraya | iṃdavo dīptā ime somāstava dyukṣāsaḥ | divi kṣiyaṃti nivasaṃtīti*
> *dyukṣāsaḥ | atastvaṃ tān dhārayeti bhāvaḥ ‖ dadhiṣka | dadhāterloṭi rūpaṃ | āgamā*
> *anudāttā itīṭo 'nudāttatvātpatyayasvaraḥ vareṇyaṃ | vṛj saṃbhaktau | vṛja eṇya|*
> *ityeṇpratyayaḥ | vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ | dyukṣāsaḥ | kṣiyateranyebhyo 'pi dṛśyata iti*
> *ḍapratyayaḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, hold (दधिष्क (*dadhiṣka*)) in your belly the pressed Soma, which is to be chosen by all. These bright Soma drops are द्युक्षासः (*dyukṣāsaḥ*) (yours): they dwell in heaven (दिवि क्षियंति निवसंतीति (*divi kṣiyaṃti nivasaṃtīti*)). Therefore you should hold them. The meaning is that you should take them in.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*)—esteemed (by all)
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—this Soma juice
- जठरे (*jaṭhare*)—in the stomach
- दधिष्व (*dadhiṣṭva*)—fill
- इंदवः (*iṃdavaḥ*)—these shining Soma juices
- तव (*tava*)—with you
- द्युक्षासः (*dyukṣāsaḥ*)—are such as dwell in the world of the gods

Gist

O Indra, fill your stomach with this Soma juice, esteemed by all and pressed by us. These shining Soma juices dwell with you in the world of the gods.

English translation

Receive, Indra, into your stomach this excellent effused libation, these bright (drops) abide with you in heaven.

Special Topics

वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*)—सर्वैर्वणेयं (*sarvairvaṇeyaṃ*). Desired or esteemed by all. Since Soma juice gives joy to those who drink it, everyone desires it. Therefore Soma juice is described here by the word वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*).

द्युक्षासः (*dyukṣāsaḥ*)—दिवि क्षियंति निवसंतीति द्युक्षासः (*divi kṣiyaṃti nivasaṃtīti dyukṣāsaḥ*). Because this Soma juice dwells in the heavenly world, or because the dwelling-place of this Soma juice is heaven, it is described here by the word द्युक्षासः (*dyukṣāsaḥ*), having its dwelling-place in heaven. On this subject there is a sentence of the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa: तृतीयस्यामितो दिवि सोम आसीत् । तं गायत्राहरत् (*tṛtīyasyāmito divi soma āsīt | taṃ gāyatrāharat*). There is a legend that formerly Soma was in heaven, and that Gāyatrī took the form of a hawk and brought it to the earth.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

गिर्व॑णः पा॒हि नः॑ सु॒तं मधो॒र्धारा॑भिरज्यसे ।
इन्द्र॒ त्वादा॑त॒मिद्यशः॑ ॥ ६ ॥

> *girvaṇaḥ pāhi naḥ sutaṃ madhordhārābhirajyase |*
> *indra tvādātamidyaśaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गिर्वणः । पाहि । नः । सुतं । मधोः । धाराभिः । अज्यसे ।
> इंद्र । त्वादातं । इत् । यशः ॥ ६ ॥

> *girvaṇaḥ | pāhi | naḥ | sutaṃ | madhoḥ | dhārābhiḥ | ajyase |*
> *iṃdra | tvādātaṃ | it | yaśaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> गिर्वणो गीर्भिर्वननीय । तथा च यास्कः । गिर्वणा देवो भवति गीर्भिरेनं वनयंति । नि. ६–१४ । इति । तादृशेंद्र नोऽस्मदियं सुतमभिषुतमिमं सोमं पाहि । पिब । यतो मधोर्मदकरस्य सोमस्य धाराभिरज्यसे सिच्यसे हे इंद्र त्वादातमित्त्वया शोधितं विशदीकृतमेव यशोऽन्नमस्मासु भवति ॥ गिर्वणः । वन संभक्तावित्यस्मादसुन् । गिर उपधाया दीर्घाभावश्छांदसः । अमंत्रितस्येति षाष्टिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं । पाहि । पा पान इत्यस्माल्लोटि रूपं । आमंत्रितस्याविद्यमानत्वेन पादादित्वादनिघातः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । त्वादातं । दैप् शोधने । सत्यपि पकारे नानुबंधकृतमनेजंतत्वमित्येजंत एवायं । तत अदेच इत्यात्वं । अस्मात्कर्मणि क्तः । दाधा घ्वदाबित्यत्रादाबिति प्रतिषेधेन घुसंज्ञाया अभावाद्धो दद्योरिति ददादेतो न भवति ।

> तैति युष्मच्छब्दस्य तृतीया कर्तकरणे कृता बहुलमिति समासः ।
> तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । यशः । अशू व्याप्तौ । अशेयुट्टेत्यसुन् । तत्संनियोगेन
> धातोर्युडागमः । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *girvaṇo gīrbhirvananīya | tathā ca yāskaḥ | girvaṇā devo bhavati*
> *gīrbhirenaṃ*
> *vanayaṃti | ni. 6-14 | iti | tādṛśeṃdra no 'smadiyaṃ*
> *sutamabhiṣutamimaṃ somaṃ*
> *pāhi | piba | yato madhormadakarasya somasya dhārābhirajyase*
> *sicyase he iṃdra*
> *tvādātamittvayā śodhitaṃ viśadīkṛtameva yaśo 'nnamasmāsu bhavati ||*
> *girvaṇaḥ | vana*
> *saṃbhaktāvityasmādasun | gira upadhāyā dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ |*
> *amaṃtritasyèti ṣāṣṭikamādyudāttatvaṃ | pāhi | pā pāna ityasmālloṭi*
> *rūpaṃ | āmaṃtritasyāvidyamānatvena*
> *pādāditvādanighātaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | tvādātaṃ | daip śodhane |*
> *satyapi pakāre nānubaṃdhakṛtamanejaṃtatvamityejaṃta evāyaṃ | tata*
> *adeca ityātvaṃ | asmātkarmaṇi ktaḥ |*
> *dādhā ghnadābityatrādābiti pratiṣedhena ghusaṃjñāyā abhāvāddo*
> *dadyoriti dadādeto na bhavati | taiti yuṣmacchabdasya tṛtīyā*
> *kartakaraṇe kṛtā bahulamiti samāsaḥ |*
> *tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | yaśaḥ | aśū vyāptau |*
> *aśeyuṭṭetyasun | tatsaṃniyogena dhātoryuḍāgamaḥ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ*
> *||*

Summary

गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*) means one to be served (वननीय (*vananīya*)) with songs of praise. So Yāska (Ni. 6-14) says that a god is गिर्वणा (*girvaṇā*) because people serve him with songs. O Indra, such as you are, drink this pressed Soma of ours, since you are sprinkled with the streams of the intoxicating Soma. O Indra, the food (यशः (*yaśaḥ*)) that is among us is cleansed and made clear by you.

Word-to-word meaning

- गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—O Indra, who are drawn by praises
- नः (*naḥ*)—offered by us
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—and pressed, the Soma

- पाहि (*pāhi*)—drink
- मधोः (*madhoḥ*)—of the intoxicating Soma
- धाराभिः (*dhārābhiḥ*)—with streams
- अज्यसे (*ajyase*)—you are drenched
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- अन्नं (*annaṃ*)—this food in the form of our oblation
- त्वादातमित् (*tvādātamit*)—has been purified by you alone

Gist

O Indra, drawn by praises, drink the Soma offered and pressed by us. You are drenched with the streams of the intoxicating Soma. O Indra, this food in the form of our oblation has been purified by you alone.

English translation

Indra, you are glorified with praise; drink this our libation, for you are sprinkled with the drops of the exhilarating (draught), the (sacrificial) food is verily purified by you.

Special Topics

गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—गीर्भिर्वननीय (*gīrbhirvananīya*). One who is described by words of praise. Yāska has given the explanation (Ni. 6-14) that a god is called गिर्वणा (*girvaṇā*) because people serve him with songs. That is, the word गिर्वणा (*girvaṇā*) means a god; for by praising him with words of praise and obtaining his favour, he is called गिर्वणा (*girvaṇā*), a god.

मधोः धाराभिः अज्यसे (*madhoḥ dhārābhiḥ ajyase*)—Here the word मधु (*madhu*) means the intoxicating Soma juice, that is, the juice that gives joy. Although the word मधु (*madhu*) by itself means only sweet or joy-giving, since Soma juice has these qualities, using the word मधु (*madhu*) to denote Soma juice is a special custom in the Ṛgveda. धाराभिः (*dhārābhiḥ*) means falling from above or flowing in a stream. When the Soma plants are pressed, the juice pours down from them as water pours down, or, so poured, it flows away and collects in the large wooden vessel, the द्रोण (*droṇa*) or कलश (*kalaśa*), kept for it. The

Soma juice that flows and collects in this way is described here by the words मधोः धाराभिः (*madhoḥ dhārābhiḥ*). The seer prays Indra: "Wet your belly with such Soma juice and refresh it."

त्पादातं इत् (*tpādātaṃ it*)—त्वया शोधितं विशदीकृतमेव (*tvayā śodhitaṃ viśadīkṛtameva*). Purified or made clear by you. The commentator says that the word दातं (*dātaṃ*) is formed here from the root दैप् शोधने (*daip śodhane*) and explains the meaning accordingly. But what the food (oblation) purified by Indra is, is not clear.?13

(continued) However, the meaning "given" or "made clear" for दातं (*dātaṃ*) fits to a fair extent. That is, the sense is: this food in the form of an oblation, which we have obtained through Indra's favour.

यशः (*yaśaḥ*)—अन्नं (*annaṃ*). The word यशः (*yaśaḥ*) is read among the 101 names of water (Ni. 2-24), among the twenty-eight names of food (Ni. 3-9) and among the twenty-eight names of wealth (Ni. 3-9). Here the commentator has taken the word यशः (*yaśaḥ*) in the sense of food and explained accordingly.?14

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒भि द्यु॒म्नानि॑ व॒निन॒ इन्द्रं॑ सचन्ते॒ अक्षि॑ता ।
पी॒त्वी सोम॑स्य वावृधे ॥ ७ ॥

> *abhi dyumnāni vanina indraṃ sacante akṣitā |*
> *pītvī somasya vāvṛdhe ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभि । द्युम्नानि । वनिनः । इंद्रं । सचंते । अक्षिता ।
> पीत्वी । सोमस्य । ववृधे ॥ ७ ॥

> *abhi | dyumnāni | vaninaḥ | iṃdraṃ | sacaṃte | akṣitā |*
> *pītvī | somasya | vavṛdhe ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वनिनः । वनं देवताविषयं संभजनमस्यास्तीति वनी । तस्य देवान् संभजमानस्य यजमानस्य
> द्युम्नानि द्योतमानान्यक्षिता क्षयरहितानि संपूर्णानि सोमादीनि हवींषींद्रमभि अभितः सचंते ।
> समवयंति । तेषु मध्यॆ सोमस्य पीत्वी
> सोमं पीत्वा वावृधे । स इंद्रो वर्धते ॥ वनिनः । अत इनिठनानितीनिप्रत्ययः ।
> तस्य स्वरः । सचंते । षच समवाय इत्यस्य लट रूपं । अक्षिता । क्षि क्षय इत्यस्य निष्ठा ।
> अत्र ण्यदर्थ इति दीर्घाभावः । तस्मादेव क्षियो दीर्घादिति निष्ठानत्ताभावः । नञा
> समासे तस्य स्वरः । पीत्वी । पा पान इत्यस्मात् क्वाप्रत्ययस्य स्नात्वादयश्चेति
> निपातनात् त्वी इत्यादेशः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । घुमास्थागापेत्यादिना ईत्वं ॥

> *vaninaḥ | vanaṃ devatāviṣayaṃ saṃbhajanamasyāstīti vanī | tasya devān saṃbhajamānasya yajamānasya dyumnāni dyotamānānyakṣitā kṣayarahitāni saṃpūrṇāni somādīni havīṃṣīṃdramabhi abhitaḥ sacaṃte | samavayaṃti | teṣu madhyè somasya pītvī*
> *somaṃ pītvā vāvṛdhe | sa iṃdro vardhate ‖ vaninaḥ | ata iniṭhanānitīnipratyayaḥ |*
> *tasya svaraḥ | sacaṃte | ṣaca samavāya ityasya laṭa rūpaṃ | akṣitā | kṣi kṣaya ityasya niṣṭhā |*
> *atra ṇyadartha iti dīrghābhāvaḥ | tasmādeva kṣiyo dīrghāditi niṣṭhānattābhāvaḥ | nañā*
> *samāse tasya svaraḥ | pītvī | pā pāna ityasmāt kvāpratyayasya snātvādayaśceti*
> *nipātanāt tvī ityādeśaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | ghumāsthāgāpetyādinā ītvaṃ ‖*

Summary

वनिनः (*vaninaḥ*): one who has वनं (*vanaṃ*), devotion directed to the deities, is वनी (*vanī*); of that sacrificer who serves the gods, the shining, undiminished (अक्षिता (*akṣitā*)), full oblations, Soma and the others, gather around (अभि (*abhi*)) Indra, they join with him (सचंते (*sacaṃte*), समवयंति (*samavayaṃti*)). Among them, having drunk the Soma (पीत्वी (*pītvī*) for सोमं पीत्वा (*somaṃ pītvā*)), that Indra grows (वावृधे (*vāvṛdhe*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- वनिनः (*vaninaḥ*)—of the sacrificer who worships the deity

- द्युम्मानि (*dyummāni*)—shining
- अक्षिता (*akṣitā*)—undiminished and full, the Soma and other oblations
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- अभि (*abhi*)—all around
- सचंते (*sacaṃte*)—pervade and join
- सोमस्य (*somasya*)—of the Soma juice
- पीर्वी (*pīrvī*)—by drinking
- वावृधे (*vāvṛdhe*)—Indra grows

Gist

The Soma and other oblations offered by the sacrificer who worships the deity, shining and undiminished and full, pervade and gather around Indra. By drinking the Soma juice Indra grows.

English translation

The brilliant and imperishable (Soma juice), offered by the worshipper, encompasses Indra ; having drunk of the libation, he increases (in vigour).

Special Topics

The meaning of this Ṛk does not fit without supplying words. Therefore the commentator has taken the words वनिनः (*vaninaḥ*) and अक्षिता (*akṣitā*) in their component senses. The word वनिनः (*vaninaḥ*), formed from the root वन संभक्तौ (*vana saṃbhaktau*), he explains as "of the sacrificer who attains or worships (the deity)", and the word अक्षिता (*akṣitā*) as indicating "imperishable or complete oblation-materials such as Soma". Although such an interpretation seems necessary to make this Ṛk clear, one should note that the Ṛk can be explained in other ways. But it should be understood that only Indra's drinking of Soma is clearly stated in this Ṛk.

पीत्वी (*pītvī*)—पीत्वा (*pītvā*). Having drunk; here the word पीत्वी (*pītvī*) is used instead of पीत्वा (*pītvā*). Likewise in the Ṛk

उभे सहस्वती भूत्वी सपत्नीं मे सहावहै । (*ubhe sahasvatī bhūtvī sapatnīṃ me sahāvahai |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-145-5)

the word भूत्वी (*bhūtvī*) is used instead of भूत्वा (*bhūtvā*). But such usages are not frequent in the Ṛgveda.

सोमस्य (*somasya*)—सोमं (*somaṃ*). Here the genitive case is used in place of the accusative. Therefore the word सोमस्य (*somasya*) must be given the accusative sense, "Soma, the Soma juice". Or सोमस्य (*somasya*) may be explained as "a small portion of the prepared Soma juice". This meaning is the more suitable. Such usages are a peculiarity of the Ṛgveda literature.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒र्वा॒वतो॑ न॒ आ ग॑हि प॒रा॒वत॑श्च वृत्रहन् ।
इ॒मा जु॑षस्व नो॒ गिर॑ः ॥ ८ ॥

> *arvāvato na ā gahi parāvataśca vṛtrahan |*
> *imā juṣasva no giraḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अर्वावतः । नः । आ । गहि । परावतः । च । वृत्रहन् ।
> इमाः। जुषस्व । नः । गिरः ॥ ८ ॥

> *arvāvataḥ | naḥ | ā | gahi | parāvataḥ | ca | vṛtrahan |*
> *imāḥ| juṣasva | naḥ | giraḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे वृत्रहन्निंद्र अर्वावतोऽर्वाचीनात्समीपाद्देशात्परावतोऽतिदूराद्देशाद्वा नोऽस्मानभिलक्ष्या गहि । आगच्छ । आगत्य च नोऽस्मदीया इमाः स्तुतिलक्षणा
> गिरो वाचो जुषस्व । सेवस्व ॥ परावतः । उपसर्गाच्छंदसि धात्वर्थ इति वतिः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *he vṛtrahanniṃdra arvāvato 'rvācīnātsamīpāddeśātparāvato 'tidūrāddeśādvā no 'smānabhilakṣyā gahi | āgaccha | āgatya ca no 'smadīyā imāḥ stutilakṣaṇā*

> *giro vāco juṣasva | sevasva || parāvataḥ | upasargācchaṃdasi*
> *dhātvartha iti vatiḥ |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: O Indra, slayer of Vṛtra, come towards us, whether from a near place (अर्वावतः (*arvāvataḥ*), "from this side") or from a very distant place (परावतः (*parāvataḥ*)). Having come, accept (जुषस्व (*juṣasva*), "serve") these praise-words (गिरः (*giraḥ*), "speech") of ours.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृत्रहन् (*vṛtrahan*)—O Indra, slayer of Vṛtra
- अर्वावतः (*arvāvataḥ*)—whether from a near place
- परावतः (*parāvataḥ*)—or from a distant place
- नः (*naḥ*)—towards us
- आ गहि (*ā gahi*)—be gracious to come
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- इमाः गिरः (*imāḥ giraḥ*)—these words in the form of praise
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept

Gist

O Indra, slayer of Vṛtra, whether from near or from a distant place, be gracious to come towards us. Accept these words of ours, which take the form of praise.

English translation

Slayer of Vritra, whether from nighl or from afar, come to us, accept these our praises.

Special Topics

Arvāvataḥ, Parāvataḥ—The word arvāk or arvāke is read among the names of nearness (Ni. 3-9), and the word parāvataḥ among the names of distance (Ni. 3-20). The meaning of this Ṛk is easy. Indra, the destroyer of Vṛtra, whether he is near or far, that is, wherever he may be, is prayed to come towards us (to our vicinity) and hear the praises we offer.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यद॑न्त॒रा प॑रा॒वत॑मर्वा॒वतं᳚ च हू॒यसे॑ ।
इन्द्रे॒ह तत॒ आ ग॑हि ॥ ९ ॥

> *yadantarā parāvatamarvāvataṃ ca hūyase |*
> *indreha tata ā gahi ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यत् । अंतरा । परावतं । अर्वावतं । च । हूयसे ।
> इंद्र । इह । ततः । आ । गहि ॥ ९ ॥

> *yat | aṃtarā | parāvataṃ | arvāvataṃ | ca | hūyase |*
> *iṃdra | iha | tataḥ | ā | gahi ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र यद्यस्मिन्नरावतमतिविप्रकृष्टस्य देशस्यार्वावतं संनिकृष्टस्य देशस्य
> चांतरा तयोर्मध्यदेशे हूयसे सम्यगिज्यसे ततस्तस्माद्देशादिहास्मिन्यज्ञ आ गहि ।
> सोमपानार्थवागच्छ ॥ परावतं अर्नावतं । अंतरांतरेण युक्ते । पा. २–३–४ ।
> इति द्वितीया । ततः । पंचम्यास्तसिल् । लित्स्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra yadyasminnarāvatamativiprakṛṣṭasya deśasyārvāvataṃ*
> *saṃnikṛṣṭasya deśasya*
> *cāṃtarā tayormadhyadeśe hūyase samyagijyase*
> *tatastasmāddeśādihāsminyajña ā gahi |*
> *somapānārthavāgaccha ‖ parāvataṃ arnāvataṃ | aṃtarāṃtareṇa yukte*
> *| pā. 2-3-4 |*
> *iti dvitīyā | tataḥ | paṃcamyāstasil | littvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, when you are invoked (हूयसे (*hūyase*), "properly worshipped") from the very distant region (परावतं (*parāvataṃ*)), from the near region (अर्वावतं (*arvāvataṃ*)), or from the middle region between the two (अंतरा (*aṃtarā*)), then from that region come here, to this sacrifice, to drink the Soma.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- यत् (*yat*)—from whichever
- परावतं (*parāvataṃ*)—from a very distant region
- अर्वावतं (*arvāvataṃ*)—or from a very near region
- च (*ca*)—and also
- अंतरा (*aṃtarā*)—from the middle region between these
- हूयसे (*hūyase*)—when you are called
- ततः (*tataḥ*)—from that region
- इह (*iha*)—to this sacrifice
- आ गहि (*ā gahi*)—be gracious to come

Gist

O Indra, whether you are called from a very distant region, from a very near region, or from the middle region between these, from that region be gracious to come to this sacrifice.

English translation

Whether you are called from nigh or from afar, or from mid space, come hither, Indra, from thence.

Special Topics

What was said in the previous Ṛk is said again here. Wherever Indra may be, even in the region lying between the far and the near, he is prayed to come to us when we call.

Sūkta 41 (Maṇḍala 3)

Anuvāda: This Sūkta beginning आ तू न इंद्र (*ā tū na iṃdra*) is the third Sūkta in the fourth Anuvāka. It has nine Ṛks. Viśvāmitra is the seer of this Sūkta, Indra the deity, Gāyatrī the metre. In the Anukramaṇikā it is listed as beginning आ तू न (*ā tū na*). In the second Paryāya of the sacrifice called Atirātra, this Sūkta and the next are applied (viniyoga) to the Śastra mantras to be recited by the priest called Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin; this is set out by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra आ तू न इंद्र मद्रगिति सूक्ते(*ā tū na iṃdra madragiti sūkte*) (Ā. Sū. 6-4).

Sūkta 41; Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 41. Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Vargas 3, 4. Number of Ṛks in the Sūkta: 9. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: Indra. Metre: Gāyatrī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ तू न॑ इन्द्र म॒द्र्य॑ग्घुवा॒नः सोम॑पीतये ।
हरि॑भ्यां याह्यद्रिवः ॥ १ ॥

> *ā tū na indra madryagghuvānaḥ somapītaye |*
> *haribhyāṃ yāhyadrivaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अ । तु । नः । इंद्र । मद्रक् । हुवानः । सोमपीतये ।
> हरिभ्यां । याहि । अद्रिवः ॥ १ ॥

> *a | tu | naḥ | iṃdra | madrak | huvānaḥ | somapītaye |*
> *haribhyāṃ | yāhi | adrivaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अद्रिवो हे वज्रन् हे इंद्र हुवानो होतृभिराहूयमानस्त्वं
> मद्रक् मदभिमुक्ति सन् नोऽस्मदीये यज्ञे सोमपीतये सोमपानार्थं
> हरिभ्यामशिभ्यां सह तु क्षिप्रिमा याहि ॥ तु । ऋचि तनुघत्यादिना संहितायां
> दीर्घः । मद्रक् । मामंचतीति ऋत्विगधृगित्यादिना क्विन् ।
> प्रत्ययोत्तरपदयोश्चेत्यस्मच्छब्दस्यैकवचने मपर्यंतस्य मादेशः । विश्वगेवयोश्च टेरद्रृंचतौ
> वप्रत्यय इति टेरदि इत्यादेशः । अद्रिसध्र्योरंतोदात्तत्वनिपातनं कृत्स्वरनिवृत्यर्थमिति
> वचनादद्रा देशोऽंतोदात्तः । यणादेशे कृत उदात्तस्वरितयोर्यण इति
> यणः स्वरितत्वं । क्विन्प्रत्ययस्य कुरिति कुत्वं । सोमपीतये !
> दासीभारादित्वात्पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरत्वं । आद्रिवः । मतुवसोरिति रुत्वं । आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः ॥

> *he adrivo he vajran he iṃdra huvāno hotṛbhirāhūyamānastvaṃ*
> *madrak madabhimukti san no 'smadīye yajñe somapītaye somapānārthaṃ*
> *haribhyāmaśibhyāṃ saha tu kṣiprimā yāhi ‖ tu | ṛci tanughatyādinā saṃhitāyāṃ*
> *dīrghaḥ | madrak | māmaṃcatīti ṛtvigadhṛgityādinā kvin |*
> *pratyayottarapadayoścetyasmacchabdasyaikavacane maparyaṃtasya mādeśaḥ | viśvagevayośca ṭeradṛṃcatau*
> *vapratyaya iti ṭeradi ityādeśaḥ | adrisadhyoraṃtodāttatvanipātanaṃ kṛtsvaranivṛtyarthamiti vacanādadrā deśo 'ṃtodāttaḥ | yaṇādeśe kṛta udāttasvaritayoryaṇa iti*
> *yaṇaḥ svaritatvaṃ | kvinpratyayasya kuriti kutvaṃ | somapītaye !*
> *dāsībhārāditvātpūrvapadaprakṛtisvaratvaṃ | ādrivaḥ | matuvasoriti rutvaṃ | āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Adrivat, O wielder of the thunderbolt, O Indra: being called by the Hotṛs, and turning towards me (मद्रक् (*madrak*), "facing me"), come quickly, together with your two horses (हरिभ्यां (*haribhyāṃ*)), to our sacrifice to drink the Soma. [Sāyaṇa then gives the grammar of तु (*tu*), मद्रक् (*madrak*), अद्रिवः (*adrivaḥ*), सोमपीतये (*somapītaye*) and the accent; omitted here.]

Word-to-word meaning

- अद्रिवः (*adrivaḥ*)—holder of the thunderbolt weapon
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- हुवानः (*huvānaḥ*)—you who are called (by the Hotṛs)
- मद्रक् (*madrak*)—turned towards me
- नः (*naḥ*)—in this sacrifice performed by us
- सोमपीतये (*somapītaye*)—in order to drink the Soma juice
- हरिभ्यां (*haribhyāṃ*)—with your two horses
- तु (*tu*)—quickly
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—be gracious to come

Gist

O Indra, bearer of the thunderbolt weapon, you who are prayed to and called by the Hotṛs, turned towards me, come quickly with your two horses to this sacrifice performed by us, in order to drink the Soma juice.

English translation

Indra, wielder of the thunderbolt, come to me with your horses, when invoked to drink the Soma at our (sacrifice).

Special Topics

Adrivaḥ—the meaning is वज्रिन् (*vajrin*), that is, O Indra, who bear the thunderbolt weapon. Yāska, explaining the meaning of the mantra

यदिंद्र चित्र मेहनास्ति त्वादातमद्रिवः । राधस्तन्नो विदद्वस उभयां स्त्या भर ॥ (*yadiṃdra citra mehanāsti tvādātamadrivaḥ | rādhastanno vidadvasa ubhayāṃ styā bhara ||*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-39-1), says of the word adrivaḥ:

अद्रिवान् । अद्रिरादृणात्येतेन । अपि वात्ते: स्यात् । ते सोमाद इति ह विज्ञायते ॥ (*adrivān | adrirādṛṇātyetena | api vātte: syāt | te somāda iti ha vijñāyate ||*) (Ni. 4-4)

He thus gives the etymology. That is: because it splits everything, being very hard like a mountain rock, adri means the thunderbolt weapon; or else the word adri may be derived from the root अन भक्षणे (*ana bhakṣaṇe*) ("to eat"). In this context, as a hard stone "eats" other things, that is, destroys them or crushes them to powder, so the thunderbolt is a weapon of hard nature like such a stone. On this point the example is ते सोमाद इति ह विज्ञायते (*te somāda iti ha vijñāyate*); the idea is that as the stones used for crushing Soma plants grind the Soma plants and make the juice flow out, so the thunderbolt, of hard nature, destroys enemies. One who holds such a thunderbolt in his hand is called adrivān. Since the thunderbolt is Indra's weapon, adrivān means Indra. The word adrivaḥ is the vocative singular. The word adri is also read among the names of the cloud (Ni. 3-21).

Haribhyām—Indra's horses are called Harī. Indra has two horses. Since haribhyām is said here, Indra is prayed to come seated in the chariot to which the two horses are yoked. Yāska, describing the vehicles of various deities, says:

हरी इंद्रस्य । रोहितोऽग्ने । हरित आदित्यस्य । रासभावश्विनेः । अजा पूष्णः । पृषत्यो मरुतां । अरुण्यो गाव उषसः । श्यावा सवितुः । विश्वरूपा बृहस्पतेः । नियुतो नायोः । (*harī iṃdrasya | rohito 'gne | harita ādityasya | rāsabhāvaśvineḥ | ajā pūṣṇaḥ | pṛṣatyo marutāṃ | aruṇyo gāva uṣasaḥ | śyāvā savituḥ | viśvarūpā bṛhaspateḥ | niyuto nāyoḥ |*)

(Ni. 3 2-28)[?15]

and thus states that Indra's vehicle is the two horses called Harī.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒त्तो होता॑ न ऋ॒त्विय॑स्तिस्ति॒रे ब॒र्हिरा॑नु॒षक् ।
अयु॑ज्रन्प्रा॒तरद्र॑यः ॥ २ ॥

> *satto hotā na ṛtviyastistire barhirānuṣak |*
> *ayujranprātaradrayaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सत्तः । होता । नः । यत्त्वियः । तिस्तिरे । बर्हिः । आनुषक् ।
> अयुज्रन् । प्रातः । अद्रयः ॥ २ ॥

> *sattaḥ | hotā | naḥ | yattviyaḥ | tistire | barhiḥ | ānuṣak |*
> *ayujran | prātaḥ | adrayaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र नोऽस्मदीये यज्ञे होता ऋत्विक् तवाह्वानार्थमृत्वियः प्राप्तकालः सन् सत्तो निषण्णो वर्तते । तथा बर्हिरानुषक् अनुसक्तं परस्परसंबद्धं
> यथा भवति तथा तिस्तिरे । हविष्वासन्नेषु स्तीर्णमभूत् । तथा प्रातः प्रातःसवने
> सोमाभिषवार्थमद्रयो ग्रावाणोऽयुज्रन् । परस्परं संगता अभूवन् । तस्मात्सोमपानार्थं
> त्वमागच्छेति भावः ॥ सत्तः । षद्ल विशरणादिष्ठित्यस्माद्यर्थाकर्मकश्लिषेत्यादिना । पा. ३–४–७२ । कर्तरि क्तः । सर्वविधीनां छंदसि विकल्पितत्वादत्र
> निष्ठातकारस्य नत्वाभावः । ऋत्वियः । ऋतुशब्दाच्छंदसि घसिति घस्पृत्ययः । घस्येयादेशः । सितीति पदसंज्ञायामोर्गुण इति भसंज्ञाधीनो गुणो न भवति ।
> यणादेशः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । तिस्तिरे । स्त्रञ् अच्छादन इत्यस्य कर्मणि लट्युत
> इड्वा तोरितीत्वं । द्विर्वचने शर्पूर्वाः खय इति तकारस्य शेषः । लिटस्तझयोरेशिरेजिति
> तप्रत्ययस्यैशित्यादेशः । पादारित्पादनिघातः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । आनुषक् । षन्ज
> संगे । क्विप् । अनिदितामिति नलोपः । आजन्वोरुपसर्गयोः प्राक्षयोगः । गतिसमासः ।
> कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । आयुज्रन् । युजिर् योग इत्यस्य लुजः ब्बीरिरितो
> वेत्यजादेशः । बहुलं छंदसीति रुडागमः । पादादित्वादनिघातः । अडागमस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra no 'smadīye yajñè hotā ṛtvik tavāhvānārthamṛtviyaḥ prāptakālaḥ san satto niṣaṇṇo vartate | tathā barhirānuṣak anusaktaṃ parasparasaṃbaddhaṃ*
> *yathā bhavati tathā tistire | haviṣvāsanneṣu stīrṇamabhūt | tathā prātaḥ prātaḥsavane*
> *somābhiṣavārthamadrayo grāvāṇo 'yujran | parasparaṃ saṃgatā abhūvan | tasmātsomapānārthaṃ tvamāgaccheti bhāvaḥ ‖ sattaḥ | ṣadla viśaraṇādiṣṭhityasmādyarthākarmakaśliṣetyādinā | pā. 3-4-72 | kartari ktaḥ | sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi vikalpitatvādatra*
> *niṣṭhātakārasya natvābhāvaḥ | ṛtviyaḥ | ṛtuśabdācchaṃdasi ghasiti ghaspṛtyayaḥ | ghasyeyādeśaḥ | sitīti padasaṃjñāyāmorguṇa iti bhasaṃjñādhīno guṇo na bhavati |*
> *yaṇādeśaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | tistire | strañ acchādana ityasya karmaṇi laṭyuta*
> *iddā toritītvaṃ | dvirvacane śarpūrvāḥ khaya iti takārasya śeṣaḥ | liṭastajhayoreśirejiti tapratyayasyèśityādeśaḥ | pādāritpādanighātaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | ānuṣak | ṣanja*
> *saṃge | kvip | aniditāmiti nalopaḥ | ājanvorupasargayoḥ prākṣayogaḥ |*

> *gatisamāsaḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | āyujran | yujir yoga ityasya lujaḥ bbīririto*
> *vetyajādeśaḥ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti ruḍāgamaḥ | pādāditvādanighātaḥ | aḍāgamasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, in our sacrifice the Hotṛ priest, having reached the proper time (ऋत्वियः (*ṛtviyaḥ*)) for your invocation, sits ready (सत्तः (*sattaḥ*)). The sacred grass (बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)) has been spread (तिस्तिरे (*tistire*)) joined together (आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)), one piece close to the next, on the seats of the oblations. And at the morning pressing the stones (अद्रयः (*adrayaḥ*)) for pressing the Soma have been brought together (अयुज्रन् (*ayujran*)), meeting one another. Therefore come to drink the Soma; such is the sense. [The rest of the block is grammar of सत्तः (*sattaḥ*), ऋत्वियः (*ṛtviyaḥ*), तिस्तिरे (*tistire*), आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*), आयुज्रन् (*āyujran*) and accents; omitted here.]

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) नः (*naḥ*)—in this sacrifice of ours
- होता (*hotā*)—the Hotṛ
- ऋत्वियः (*ṛtviyaḥ*)—at the right time of your invocation (at the right time of calling you to the sacrifice)
- सत्तः (*sattaḥ*)—is seated
- बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)—the darbha grass
- आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)—as if joined to one another
- तिस्तिरे (*tistire*)—has been spread on the altar (in the respective places)
- अद्रयः (*adrayaḥ*)—the stones for pressing the Soma
- आयुज्रन् (*āyujran*)—have been placed together

Gist

O Indra, in our sacrifice the Hotṛ has come and sat down at the right time, when he prays to you and calls you. The seats of darbha grass have been spread all around the altar. The stones for pressing the Soma juice have been placed together.

English translation

The invoking priest is seated at the proper season; the sacred grass woven together has been spread; the stones are placed in contact for the morning (libation).

Special Topics

Naḥ hotā ṛtviyaḥ sattaḥ—here naḥ may be given the meaning "our", or else, supplying the word यज्ञे (*yajñe*), the meaning

"in our sacrifice" may be stated. For the word ṛtviyaḥ the commentator explains प्राप्तकालः सन् (*prāptakālaḥ san*), "having come at the right time". That is: the sacrifice begins in the morning; the Prātaḥsavana as well, that is, the rite of pressing the Soma juice, takes place in the morning itself. Therefore the priest called Hotṛ, who invokes the gods in the sacrifice, has come and sits on the sacrificial ground at the proper time, not late, that is, in the morning itself, in order to do his duty; such is the idea.

Tistire barhiḥ ānuṣak—[Sāyaṇa:] परस्परसंबद्धं यथा भवति तथा बर्हिःष्वासन्नेषु स्त्रीण मभूत् (*parasparasaṃbaddhaṃ yathā bhavati tathā barhiḥṣvāsanneṣu strīṇa mabhūt*) ("spread on the seats of the oblations in such a way that the blades are joined to one another"). In this sacrifice the darbha grass called barhiḥ, cut evenly, has been spread joined together, so that the gods may come to the sacrificial ground and sit; that is, the darbhas are not spread far apart. They are joined to one another, laid layer upon layer, one layer over another, spread so that the seat is soft. Three layers are thus spread one over the other and the seat is prepared to be soft. This is called barhiḥ. For the word ānuṣak Yāska says: आनुषगिति नामानुपूर्वस्यानुषक्तं भवति (*ānuṣagiti nāmānupūrvasyānuṣaktaṃ bhavati*); and the Nigama also is स्त्रणंति बर्हिरानुषक् (*straṇaṃti barhirānuṣak*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-45-1), (Ni. 6-14). Ānuṣak means mutually, or without a gap, joined one to another; the idea is "not sparse, pressed close". To show that this word is used when darbha is spread pressed close together, Yāska cites the Ṛk स्तृणंति बर्हिरानुषक् (*stṛṇaṃti barhirānuṣak*).

Adrayaḥ ayujran—ग्रावाणः परस्परं संगता अभूवन् (*grāvāṇaḥ parasparaṃ saṃgatā abhūvan*) ("the stones have come together with one another"): the stones for pressing the Soma juice have been placed one beside another; such is the idea.

Now everything is ready in the sacrifice we perform. The priest called Hotṛ has come at the right time to invoke the gods, has sat in his place and is ready. The darbhas have been spread close together, and a soft seat is ready for the gods to come to the sacrificial ground and sit. The stones for crushing the Soma plants and pressing the juice have been placed close by. Since everything is thus ready, O Indra, he is prayed to come quickly to our sacrificial ground to drink the Soma.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मा ब्रह्म॑ ब्रह्मवाहः क्रि॒यन्त॒ आ ब॒र्हिः सी॑द ।
वी॒हि शू॑र पुरो॒ळाशं॑म् ॥ ३ ॥

> *imā brahma brahmavāhaḥ kriyanta ā barhiḥ sīda |*
> *vīhi śūra puroḷāśam ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमा । ब्रह्म । ब्रह्मवाहः । क्रियंते । आ । बर्हिः । सीद ।
> वीहि । शूर । पुरोळाशं ॥ ३ ॥

> *imā | brahma | brahmavāhaḥ | kriyaṃte | ā | barhiḥ | sīda |*
> *vīhi | śūra | puroḷāśaṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> बह्माणि स्तोत्राणि स्तुत्यतया वहतीति ब्रह्मवाहा ब्रह्मणा स्तोत्रेण प्राप्यत
> इति ना । हे ब्रह्मवाह इंद्र तुभ्यमिमेमानि ब्रह्म ब्रह्माणि स्तोत्राण्यस्माभिः
> क्रियंते । अतो बर्हिरा सीद । स्तुत्यतया बर्हिषि यज्ञ उपनिश । हे शूर
> समर्थेंद्रास्माभिर्दीयमानमिमं पुरोडाशं पुरोडाशाख्यं हनिर्विहि । भक्षय ॥
> ब्रह्मवाहः । वह प्रापण इत्यस्माद्वहिहाधाञ्छंदसीत्यसुन् । णिदित्यनुवृत्तेरुपधावृद्धिः ।

> आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः । क्रियंते । करोतेः कर्मणि यक् । रिज् शयग्लिंक्षिति रिणादेशः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । पादादित्पादनिघातः । बर्हिः । कालाध्वनोरत्यंतसंयोगे द्वितीया । वीहि । वी
> कांत्यादिषु । लोटि रूपं । हेर्जित्वादुदात्तः
> पुरोळाशं । दाश्य दान इत्यस्मात्पुरस्पूर्वान्मंत्रे श्वेतवहोक्तशस्पुरोडाशो
> ण्वन् । पुरो दाशंत एनमिति । निपातनाद्दकारस्य ळकारः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः ॥

> *bahmāṇi stotrāṇi stutyatayā vahatīti brahmavāhā brahmaṇā stotreṇa prāpyata*
> *iti nā | he brahmavāha iṃdra tubhyamimemāni brahma brahmāṇi stotrāṇyasmābhiḥ*
> *kriyaṃte | ato barhirā sīda | stutyatayā barhiṣi yajña upaniśa | he śūra samartheṃdrāsmābhirdīyamānamimaṃ puroḍāśaṃ puroḍāśākhyaṃ hanirvihi | bhakṣaya ‖*
> *brahmavāhaḥ | vaha prāpaṇa ityasmādvahihādhāñchaṃdasītyasun | ṇidityanuvṛtterupadhāvṛddhiḥ | āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ | kriyaṃte | karoteḥ karmaṇi yak | rij śayagliṃkṣiti riṇādeśaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | pādāditpādanighātaḥ | barhiḥ | kālādhvanoratyaṃtasaṃyoge dvitīyā | vīhi | vī kāṃtyādiṣu | loṭi rūpaṃ | herjitvādudāttaḥ*
> *puroḷāśaṃ | dāśya dāna ityasmātpuraspūrvānmaṃtre śvetavahoktaśaspuroḍāśo*
> *ṇvan | puro dāśaṃta enamiti | nipātanāddakārasya ḷakāraḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

ब्रह्मवाहः (*brahmavāhaḥ*) is explained as one who carries *brahmāṇi*, hymns of praise, as objects of praise; or as one who is reached by *brahma*, a hymn. "O Indra, bearer of prayers, these *brahma*, that is, hymns, are made by us for you. Therefore sit down on the sacred grass; take your seat on the *barhis* at the sacrifice, being praised. O hero, O capable Indra, eat this oblation called *purodāśa*, which is being given by us."

Word-to-word meaning

- ब्रह्मवाहः (*brahmavāhaḥ*)—O Indra, who, pleased by praises, approach us
- इमा ब्रह्म (*imā brahma*)—these praises
- क्रियंते (*kriyaṃte*)—are made by us (therefore)

- बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)—upon the seat of darbha grass
- आ सीद (*ā sīda*)—sit down
- शूर (*śūra*)—O capable Indra
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—this oblation in the form of *purodāśa*
- वीहि (*vīhi*)—eat

Gist

O Indra, who, pleased by praises, approach us: these praises have been made by us. Therefore sit down on the seat of darbha grass. O capable Indra, eat this oblation in the form of *purodāśa*.

English translation

Bearer of prayers, these prayers are offered (by us): sit down on the sacred grass : partake, hero, of the oblation.

Special Topics

ब्रह्मवाहः (*brahmavāhaḥ*)—This is the vocative singular. It is used to address Indra. *Brahma* means a hymn. Because he comes to our presence, praised with such hymns, he is called by the word ब्रह्मवाहः (*brahmavāhaḥ*).

इमा ब्रह्म क्रियंते (*imā brahma kriyaṃte*)—इमानि स्तोत्राणि अस्माभिः क्रियंते । (*imāni stotrāṇi asmābhiḥ kriyaṃte* |) These hymns are made by us. Although the singular *brahma* is used here, it must be taken to mean the plural *brahmāṇi*. For the word इमाः (*imāḥ*) that qualifies it and the verb क्रियंते (*kriyaṃte*) are both plural, so the word *brahma* too must be regarded as plural.

आ बर्हिः सीद (*ā barhiḥ sīda*)—Sit down on this seat of darbha grass that has been prepared.

शूर पुरोळाशं वीहि (*śūra puroḷāśaṃ vīhi*)—O capable Indra, eat this oblation called *purodāśa* that we now offer you. *Purodāśa* means पुरो दाशंत एनमिति । निपातनाद्दकारस्य ळकारः (*puro dāśaṃta enamiti* | *nipātanāddakārasya ḷakāraḥ*): because this is offered to the gods in front of the sacrificial altar, this oblation is called *purodāśa*.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

रा॒र॒न्धि सव॑नेषु ण ए॒षु स्तोमे॑षु वृत्रहन् ।
उ॒क्थेष्वि॑न्द्र गिर्वणः ॥ ४ ॥

> *rārandhi savaneṣu ṇa eṣu stomeṣu vṛtrahan |*
> *uktheṣvindra girvaṇaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ररंधि । सवनेषु । नः । एषु । स्तोमेषु । वृत्रहन् ।
> उक्षेषु । इंद्र । गिर्वणः ॥ ४ ॥

> *raraṃdhi | savaneṣu | naḥ | eṣu | stomeṣu | vṛtrahan |*
> *ukṣeṣu | iṃdra | girvaṇaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे गिर्वणो गीर्भिः स्तुतिभिर्वननीय वृत्रहन् वृत्रस्य हंतर्हे इंद्र
> नोऽस्माकं संबंधिषु त्रिषु सवनेष्वेषु क्रियमाणेषु सोमेषु सोत्रेषूक्षेषु शस्त्रेषु च रारंधि । रमस्व ॥
> रारंधि । रमतेर्लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति शपः
> श्लुः । छंदस्युभयथेति हेरार्धधातुकत्वेनाजित्तादजतश्चति हेर्धिः । सवनेषु ।
> सूयते सोमो येष्वत्यधिकरणे सुनोतेल्र्युट् । लित्स्वरः । णः । नसो नकारस्य
> नश्च धातुस्थोरुषभ्य इति संहितायां णत्वं ॥

> *he girvaṇo gīrbhiḥ stutibhirvananīya vṛtrahan vṛtrasya haṃtarhe iṃdra*
> *no 'smākaṃ saṃbaṃdhiṣu triṣu savaneṣveṣu kriyamāṇeṣu someṣu*
> *sotreṣūkṣeṣu śastreṣu ca rāraṃdhi | ramasva ‖ rāraṃdhi | ramaterloṭi*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ*
> *śluḥ | chaṃdasyubhayatheti herārdhadhātukatvenājittādajataścati*
> *herdhiḥ | savaneṣu |*
> *sūyate somo yeṣvatyadhikaraṇe sunotelryuṭ | litsvaraḥ | ṇaḥ | naso*
> *nakārasya*
> *naśca dhātusthoruṣabhya iti saṃhitāyāṃ ṇatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, to be won (*vananīya*) by songs, that is, by praises; O slayer of Vṛtra, take your pleasure in these three pressings of ours, and in the Soma-hymns (*stoma*) and the recitations (*ukthā*, *śastra*) that are performed in them." रारंधि (*rāraṃdhi*) means "take delight". सवनेषु (*savaneṣu*) means those in which Soma is pressed.

Word-to-word meaning

- गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—you who are pleased by praises
- वृत्रहन् (*vṛtrahan*)—and are the slayer of Vṛtra
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—performed by us
- सवनेषु (*savaneṣu*)—in the three pressings too
- विषु (*viṣu*)—(broken in print; continues on the next page)[?16]
- पल्पडुव (*palpaḍuva*)—(…performed)[?17]
- स्तोमेषु (*stomeṣu*)—by praises in the form of *stoma*
- उक्षेषु (*ukṣeṣu*)—by the *stoma* in the form of *śastra*
- रारंभि (*rāraṃbhi*)—take delight (be satisfied)

Gist

O Indra, who are pleased by praises and are the slayer of Vṛtra: in the three pressings performed by us, take delight, and obtain satisfaction, through the praises in the form of *stoma* that are made here and through the praises in the form of *śastra*.

English translation

Slayer of Vritra, Indra, you are gratified by praise, be pleased with these our praises and prayers at our (daily) secrifices.

Special Topics

गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—गीर्भिः स्तूतिभिर्वननीय । (*gīrbhiḥ stūtibhirvananīya* |) One who is attained through words in the form of hymns; that is, one who hears the hymns we make, is pleased, and comes into our presence.

वृत्रहन् (*vṛtrahan*)—O Indra, destroyer of Vṛtra. Indra's most prominent heroic deed is the destruction of Vṛtra. Hence calling Indra the destroyer of Vṛtra is common in the Ṛgveda.

सवनेषु (*savaneṣu*)—There are three pressings: the morning pressing, the midday pressing and the third pressing. The Soma plants are crushed with stones, the Soma juice is extracted, filtered and offered to the gods. This work must be done with mantras. In sacrifices it is done in the morning, at midday and in the evening. The day on which this Soma-pressing is done is called the *sutyā* day. We have explained this matter at length before.

स्तोमेषु (*stomeṣu*)—Vedic mantras in the form of hymns. For a detailed explanation of these *stoma*, see what we have explained in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 2, page 138.

उक्षेषु (*ukṣeṣu*)—The Vedic mantras used when invoking the gods are called *śastra* mantras. Ordinarily the word *uktha* is used to denote this kind of mantras and also hymns. For a detailed explanation of this word see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 8-252, 10-695, 13-421.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒तयः॑ सोम॒पामु॒रुं रि॒हन्ति॒ शव॑स॒स्पति॑म् ।
इन्द्रं᳚ व॒त्सं न मा॒तरः॑ ॥ ५ ॥

> *matayaḥ somapāmuruṃ rihanti śavasaspatim |*
> *indraṃ vatsaṃ na mātaraḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मतयः । सोमसां । उरुं । रिहंति । शवसः । पतिं ।
> इंद्रं । वत्सं । न । मातरः ॥ ५ ॥

> *matayaḥ | somasāṃ | uruṃ | rihaṃti | śavasaḥ | patiṃ |*
> *iṃdraṃ | vatsaṃ | na | mātaraḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र मतयोऽस्माभिः क्रियमाणाः स्तुतय उरुं महांतं सोमसां
> सोमस्य पातारं शवसो बलस्य पतिमिंद्रं त्वां रिहंति । लिहंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः ।
> वत्सं न । यथा वत्सं मातरो धेनवो लिहंति तद्वत् ॥ मतयः । मन ज्ञान इत्यस्मात्कर्मणि मंत्रे
> वृषेत्यादिना क्तिन्नु दात्तः । उरुं । ऊर्णुञ् आच्छादन इत्यस्मान्महत्यर्थे गम्यमाने महति
> ह्रस्वश्च । उ. १–३२ । इति कुप्रत्ययो धातोर्ह्रस्वश्च ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । रिहंति । लिह आस्वादन इत्यस्य लटि रूपं । रलयोरभेदः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ।
> शवसस्पतिमिति संहितायां षष्ठ्याः पतिपुत्र स्पष्टेत्यादिना विसर्जनीयस्य सत्वं ।
> वत्सं । वद व्यक्तायां वाचि । अस्माद्वृत्यवदिहनीत्यादिना सप्रत्ययः । वदत्यभीक्ष्णं
> मातरमिति वेत्सो गोबालः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ¡¡

> *he iṃdra matayo 'smābhiḥ kriyamāṇāḥ stutaya uruṃ mahāṃtaṃ somasāṃ*
> *somasya pātāraṃ śavaso balasya patimiṃdraṃ tvāṃ rihaṃti | lihaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *vatsaṃ na | yathā vatsaṃ mātaro dhenavo lihaṃti tadvat ‖ matayaḥ | mana jñāna ityasmātkarmaṇi maṃtre vṛṣetyādinā kkinnu dāttaḥ | uruṃ | ūrṇuñ ācchādana ityasmānmahatyarthe gamyamāne mahati hrasvaśca | u. 1-32 | iti kupratyayo dhātorhrasvaśca |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ | rihaṃti | liha āsvādana ityasya laṭi rūpaṃ | ralayorabhedaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | śavasaspatimiti saṃhitāyāṃ ṣaṣṭhyāḥ patiputra spaṣṭetyādinā visarjanīyasya satvaṃ |*
> *vatsaṃ | vada vyaktāyāṃ vāci | asmādvṛtyavadihanītyādinā sapratyayaḥ | vadatyabhīkṣṇaṃ*
> *mātaramiti vètso gobālaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ii*

Summary

"O Indra, the hymns (*mati*) made by us lick you, the great one, the drinker of Soma, the lord of strength (*śavas*)." रिहंति (*rihaṃti*) is लिहंति (*lihaṃti*) (r and l are not distinguished). The illustration is वत्सं न (*vatsaṃ na*): as mother cows lick the calf, so. मतयः (*matayaḥ*) is from the root *man* (to know). उरुं (*uruṃ*) is from *ūrṇuñ* (to cover), with the sense "great" (Uṇ. Sū. 1-32). वत्सं (*vatsaṃ*) is from *vad* (to speak clearly): the calf is one who constantly "speaks" to its mother; a young cow-child.

Word-to-word meaning

- मतयः (*matayaḥ*)—(O Indra,) the praises made by us
- उरुं (*uruṃ*)—you of mighty form
- सोमपां (*somapāṃ*)—drinker of Soma juice
- शवस्य (*śavasya*)—of strength
- पतिं (*patiṃ*)—lord
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—you, who are Indra
- मातरः (*mātaraḥ*)—cows
- वत्सं न (*vatsaṃ na*)—as they lovingly lick their calves
- रिहंति (*rihaṃti*)—lick (become one with you)

Gist

O Indra, these praises made by us lick you, who are of mighty form, the drinker of Soma juice, the lord of strength, in the form of Indra, as cows lovingly lick their calves. That is, they become one with you and bring you delight.

English translation

Our praises caress the mighty Indra, the drinker of the Soma juice. as cows lick their calves.

Special Topics

मतयः (*matayaḥ*)—The word मतयः (*matayaḥ*) is formed from the root *man jñāne* and is read among the names of the wise (Ni. 3-9). But here the word *mati* means intellect or mantra. That is, hymn-sentences that we recite with understanding.

शवस्य पतिं (*śavasya patiṃ*)—The word *śavas* is read among the one hundred and one names of water (Ni. 2-24) and among the twenty-eight names of strength (Ni. 3-9). Here it is used in the sense of strength. "Lord of strength" means exceedingly strong.

मातरः वत्सं न रिहंति (*mātaraḥ vatsaṃ na rihaṃti*)—यथा धेनवो वत्सं लिहंति तद्वत् । (*yathā dhenavo vatsaṃ lihaṃti tadvat* |) Just as cows lovingly lick their calves, so the hymns we make lick you (Indra); that is, reach you. The meaning is that the hymns we make with great reverence touch you, Indra, and bring you love and delight. As cows have love for their calves, so we have love (devotion) for Indra; with such love we make our hymns. This is the purport of the illustration.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स म॑न्दस्वा॒ ह्य॑न्ध॑सो॒ राध॑से त॒न्वा॑ म॒हे ।
न स्तो॒तारं॑ नि॒दे क॑रः ॥ ६ ॥

> *sa mandasvā hyandhaso rādhase tanvā mahe |*
> *na stotāraṃ nide karaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सु । मंदस्व । हि ! अंधस । राधसे । तन्वा । महे ।
> न । स्तोतारं । निदे । करः ॥ ६ ॥

> *su | maṃdasva | hi ! aṃdhasa | rādhase | tanvā | mahe |*
> *na | stotāraṃ | nide | karaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र स तथाविधस्त्वं महे महते राधसे धनायांधसोऽस्माभिर्दीयमानस्य सोमस्य पानेन तन्ना शरीरेण सह मंदस्व । हृष्टो भव । हिरत्र समुच्चयार्थः । किं च त्वं स्तोतारं मां निदे निंदाय्कें विषयभूतं न करः । मा
> कार्षिः ॥ मंदस्व । मदि स्तुत्यादिष्ठित्यस्य लोटि रूपं । हि चेति निघातप्रतिषेधेन
> भवितव्यमिति चेन्न । तत्राप्रातिलोम्य इति वर्तते । अत्र हेः समुच्चयार्थत्वान्नि–

> *he iṃdra sa tathāvidhastvaṃ mahe mahate rādhase dhanāyāṃdhaso 'smābhirdīyamānasya somasya pānena tannā śarīreṇa saha maṃdasva | hṛṣṭo bhava | hiratra samuccayārthaḥ | kiṃ ca tvaṃ stotāraṃ māṃ nide niṃdāykè viṣayabhūtaṃ na karaḥ | mā*
> *kārṣiḥ ‖ maṃdasva | madi stutyādiṣṭhityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | hi ceti nighātapratiṣedhena*
> *bhavitavyamiti cenna | tatrāprātilomya iti vartate | atra heḥ samuccayārthatvānni-*

> घातः । तन्ना । उदात्तस्वरितयोरिति स्वरितत्वं । महे । तकारलोपश्छंदसः । बृहन्महतोरुपसंख्यानमिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । निदे । णिदि कुत्सायामित्यस्मात्संपदादिलक्षणो भावे क्विप् । आगमानुशासनस्यानित्यत्वान्नु मभावः । सावेकाच इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । करः । करोतेर्लुजं ज्लेः क्रमृद्यरुहिभ्यश्चंदसीत्यजादेशः । निघातः ॥

> *ghātaḥ | tannā | udāttasvaritayoriti svaritatvaṃ | mahe | takāralopaśchaṃdasaḥ | bṛhanmahatorupasaṃkhyānamiti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | nide | ṇidi kutsāyāmityasmātsaṃpadādilakṣaṇo bhāve kvip | āgamānuśāsanasyānityatvānnu mabhāvaḥ | sāvekāca iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | karaḥ | karoterlujaṃ jleḥ kramṛdyaruhibhyaścaṃdasītyajādeśaḥ | nighātaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Indra, you, such as you are, rejoice together with your body (तन्ना (*tannā*)) on drinking the Soma (*andhas*) given by us, for great wealth (*rādhas*). Be glad. हि (*hi*) here has the sense of conjunction. And do not make me, your praiser, an object of reproach (निदे (*nide*))." मंदस्व (*maṃdasva*) is the imperative of *mad*, in the sense of praising and the like.

निदे (*nide*) is from *ṇid* (to blame). करः (*karaḥ*) is from *kṛ* in the aorist-injunctive sense (the "*luk*" form).

Word-to-word meaning

- सः (*saḥ*)—you, of such greatness
- महे (*mahe*)—abundant
- राधसे (*rādhase*)—for obtaining wealth
- अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*)—by drinking Soma (given by us)
- तन्वा (*tanvā*)—with bodily strength
- मंदस्व (*maṃdasva*)—be gladdened
- हि (*hi*)—and
- स्तोतारं (*stotāraṃ*)—me, who praise you
- निदे (*nide*)—as a target of reproach
- न करः (*na karaḥ*)—do not make

Gist

O Indra, you of great majesty, for the sake of our obtaining wealth, be gladdened, with bodily strength, by drinking the Soma given by us. Do not make me, who praise you, a target of reproach.

English translation

Be exhilarated bodily (by drinking) of the libation which we offer for the sake of ample wealth : expose not your adorer to reproach.

Special Topics

सः (*saḥ*)—Here the word *tad* is used instead of *yuṣmad*. That is, the commentators give the word सः (*saḥ*) the meaning त्वं (*tvaṃ*), "you". For the verb मंदस्व (*maṃdasva*), "be gladdened", in this sentence is in the second person, so even though the subject word सः (*saḥ*) is in the third person, it is proper to give it the sense of the second person.

राधसे (*rādhase*)—The word *rādhas* is read among the twenty-eight names of wealth beginning with *magham*, *rekṣas* (Ni. 3-9), and Yāska has given the etymology "*rādha* is a name for wealth; by it they succeed" (Ni. 4-4).

अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*)—The word *andhas* is read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9). As we said before, the word *andhas* is used here to denote Soma juice.

स्तोतारं निदे न करः (*stotāraṃ nide na karaḥ*)—त्वं स्तोतारं मां निंदायै विषयभूतं मा कार्षिः । (*tvaṃ stotāraṃ māṃ niṃdāyai viṣayabhūtaṃ mā kārṣiḥ |*) O Indra, do not let me, who am praising you, become an object of blame. That is, let no one reproach me.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

व॒यमि॑न्द्र त्वा॒यवो॑ ह॒विष्म॑न्तो जरामहे ।
उ॒त त्वम॑स्म॒युर्व॑सो ॥ ७ ॥

> *vayamindra tvāyavo haviṣmanto jarāmahe |*
> *uta tvamasmayurvaso ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वयं । इंद्र । त्वायवः । हविष्मंतः । जरामहे ।
> उत । त्वं । अस्मयुः । वसो इति । ७ ॥

> *vayaṃ | iṃdra | tvāyavaḥ | haviṣmaṃtaḥ | jarāmahe |*
> *uta | tvaṃ | asmayuḥ | vaso iti | 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वायवो यज्ञार्थं त्वामात्मन इच्छंतस्त्वत्कामाः संतो हनिष्मंतः संभृतहविष्का वयं जरामहे । त्वां स्तुमः । हे वसो सर्वस्य वासक इंद्र
> उत त्वमप्यस्मयुरस्मदीयहविः स्वीकरणार्थमस्मानात्मन इच्छन् भव ॥ त्वायवः ।
> त्वामिच्छंतीत्यर्थे सुपः आत्मनः क्यच् । प्रत्ययोत्तरपदयोश्चति मपर्यंतस्य
> त्वादेशः । क्याच्छंदसीत्युप्रत्ययः । त्वदृव इति प्राप्तौ युष्मदस्मदोरनादेश इत्यविभक्तावपि हलादौ व्यत्ययेनात्वं । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हनिष्मंतः । तसौ मत्वर्थ इति
> भसंज्ञायां सकारस्य रुत्वाभावः । स्वरविधौ व्यंजनमविद्यमानवदिति परिभाषानाश्रयणान्मतुप उदात्तताभावः । इसिप्रत्ययस्वरः । जरामहे । जरतिः स्तुतिकर्मेति यास्कः । अस्मयुः : अस्मानिच्छतीत्यर्थे सुपः क्यच् । तस्मादुप्रत्ययः । पूर्वपदांतलोपश्चांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra tvāyavo yajñārthaṃ tvāmātmana icchaṃtastvatkāmāḥ saṃto hanişmaṃtaḥ saṃbhṛtahaviṣkā vayaṃ jarāmahe | tvāṃ stumaḥ | he vaso sarvasya vāsaka iṃdra*
> *uta tvamapyasmayurasmadīyahaviḥ svīkaraṇārthamasmānātmana icchan bhava ‖ tvāyavaḥ |*
> *tvāmicchaṃtītyarthe supaḥ ātmanaḥ kyac | pratyayottarapadayośati maparyaṃtasya*
> *tvādeśaḥ | kyācchaṃdasītyupratyayaḥ | tvadṛva iti prāptau yuṣmadasmadoranādeśa ityavibhaktāvapi halādau vyatyayenātvaṃ | pratyayasvaraḥ | hanişmaṃtaḥ | tasau matvartha iti*
> *bhasaṃjñāyāṃ sakārasya rutvābhāvaḥ | svaravidhau vyaṃjanamavidyamānavaditi paribhāṣānāśrayaṇānmatupa udāttatābhāvaḥ | isipratyayasvaraḥ | jarāmahe | jaratiḥ stutikarmeti yāskaḥ | asmayuḥ : asmānicchatītyarthe supaḥ kyac | tasmādupratyayaḥ | pūrvapadāṃtalopaścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, we desire you for the sake of the sacrifice, longing for you, and with our oblations gathered together we praise you (जरामहे (*jarāmahe*); Sāyaṇa glosses it "we praise you"). O Vasu, you who give dwelling to all, be desirous of us as well, wishing for us so that you may accept our oblation. Sāyaṇa explains त्वायवः (*tvāyavaḥ*) as "those who desire you", and अस्मयुः (*asmayuḥ*) as "one who desires us". He cites Yāska: जरतिः स्तुतिकर्मेति यास्कः (*jaratiḥ stutikarmeti yāskaḥ*) (jarati is a verb of praising).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वायवः (*tvāyavaḥ*)—we who with faith desire your favour
- हविष्मंतः (*haviṣmaṃtaḥ*)—who possess oblations
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- जरामहे (*jarāmahe*)—praise you
- वसो (*vaso*)—O Indra, giver of dwelling to all
- उत त्वं (*uta tvaṃ*)—you also
- अस्मयुः (*asmayuḥ*)—be desirous of accepting our oblation

Gist

O Indra, we who with faith desire your favour and who possess oblations praise you. O Indra, giver of dwelling to all, you too be desirous of accepting our oblation.

English translation

Devoted, Indra, to you, and offering oblations, we glorify you, giver of dwellings: be favourably disposed to us.

Special Topics

The meaning of this Ṛk is easy. There are no difficult words and no obscurity of meaning. O Indra, in order to win your favour we have prepared oblations to offer you and are praising you. The main idea is: "You, giver of dwelling to all, come near us and accept the oblation."

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मारे अ॒स्मद्वि मु॑मुचो॒ हरि॑प्रिया॒र्वाङ्या॑हि ।
इन्द्र॑ स्वधावो॒ मत्स्वे॒ह ॥ ८ ॥

> *māre asmadvi mumuco haripriyārvāṅyāhi |*
> *indra svadhāvo matsveha ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मा । आरे । अस्मत् । वि । मुमुचः । हरिप्रियॆ । अर्वाण् । याहि ।
> इंद्र । स्वध्वावः । मत्स्य । इह ॥ ८ ॥

> *mā | āre | asmat | vi | mumucaḥ | haripriyè | arvāṇ | yāhi |*
> *iṃdra | svadhvāvaḥ | matsya | iha ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे हरिप्रिय हरी अश्वा प्रियौ यस्य तादृश हे इंद्र अस्मदस्मत्त आरे दूरे
> रथे योजतावश्वा मा वि मुमुचः । मा विमोचय । ताभ्यामुपेत एनार्वाज्
> अस्मदाभिमुख्येन याहि । आगच्छ । हे स्वधावः सोमलक्षणान्नवन्निंद्र इहास्मिन्देवयजने
> मत्स्य । सोमं पीत्वा हृष्टो भव ॥ आस्मत् । अस्मच्छब्दस्य पंचमीबहुवचनस्य पंचम्या अत् ।
> पा. ७–१–३१ । इत्यदादेशः । मुमुचः । मुच्चै मोक्षण
> इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य छांदसे लुजि चजि रूपं । अभ्यासस्य दीर्घाभावश्चांदसः । न
> माज्योग इत्यडभावः । निघातः । हरिप्रिय । आमंत्रितस्य पादादित्वात्पाष्ठिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> मत्स्य । मदि स्तुत्यादिश्वित्यस्य लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् ।
> अमंत्रितस्याविद्यमानत्वेन पादादित्वादनिघातः ॥

> *he haripriya harī aśvā priyau yasya tādṛśa he iṃdra asmadasmatta āre dūre*
> *rathe yojatāvaśvā mā vi mumucaḥ | mā vimocaya | tābhyāmupeta enārvāj*
> *asmadābhimukhyena yāhi | āgaccha | he svadhāvaḥ somalakṣaṇānnavanniṃdra ihāsmindevayajane matsya | somaṃ pītvā hṛṣṭo bhava ‖ āsmat | asmacchabdasya paṃcamībahuvacanasya paṃcamyā at | pā. 7-1-31 | ityadādeśaḥ | mumucaḥ | muccai mokṣaṇa*
> *ityasya ṇyaṃtasya chāṃdase luji caji rūpaṃ | abhyāsasya*

> *dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | na*
> *mājyoga ityaḍabhāvaḥ | nighātaḥ | haripriya | āmaṃtritasya*
> *pādāditvātpāṣṭhikamādyudāttatvaṃ | matsya | madi stutyādiśvityasya*
> *loṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk |*
> *amaṃtritasyāvidyamānatvena pādāditvādanighātaḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, "whose two horses (hari) are dear" (हरिप्रिय (*haripriya*)), do not unyoke the two horses yoked to the chariot while you are far from us (मा वि मुमुचः (*mā vi mumucaḥ*): "do not release"). Provided with them, come (याहि (*yāhi*): "arrive") facing us (अर्वाण् (*arvāṇ*)). O Indra, स्वधावः (*svadhāvaḥ*), possessor of food in the form of Soma, rejoice (मत्स्य (*matsya*)) here, in this place of worship of the gods: having drunk Soma, be gladdened.

Word-to-word meaning

- हरिप्रिय (*haripriya*)—O Indra, lover of horses
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—from our place of sacrifice
- आरे (*āre*)—far away
- मा वि मुमुचः (*mā vi mumucaḥ*)—do not unyoke the horses from the chariot and let them go
- अर्वाज् (*arvāj*)—facing us (with them)
- याहि (*yāhi*)—graciously come
- स्वधावः (*svadhāvaḥ*)—possessor of food in the form of Soma
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- इह (*iha*)—in this place of sacrifice
- मत्स्य (*matsya*)—be satisfied by drinking Soma

Gist

O Indra, lover of horses, do not unyoke your horses from the chariot while far from our place of sacrifice. Come graciously with them, facing us. O Indra, possessor of food in the form of Soma, be satisfied in this place of sacrifice by drinking Soma.

English translation

Lover of horses, Indra, loosen not your steeds while far from us, but come (with them) to our presence : enjoyer of the offering, be exhilarated at this sacrifice.

Special Topics

हरिप्रिय (*haripriya*)—Hari means the two horses of Indra. Because Indra is fond of them, Indra is here addressed by the word hari-priya.

अस्मत् मा आरे वि मुमुचः (*asmat mā āre vi mumucaḥ*)—O Indra, do not unyoke your horses from the chariot far from us. That is, keep your horses yoked to the chariot until you reach our neighbourhood. Seated in the chariot, unyoke the horses after you have come near us. Do not stop the journey midway by unyoking the horses before then. So Indra is entreated.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒र्वाञ्चं॑ त्वा सु॒खे रथे॒ वह॑तामिन्द्र के॒शिना॑ ।
घृ॒तस्नू॑ ब॒र्हिरा॒सदे॑ ॥ ९ ॥

> *arvāñcaṃ tvā sukhe rathe vahatāmindra keśinā |*
> *ghṛtasnū barhirāsade ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अर्वाञ्छं । त्वा । सुखे । रथे । वहतां । इंद्र । केशिना ।
> घृतस्नू इति घृतस्नू । बर्हिः । आसदे ॥ ९ ॥

> *arvāñchaṃ | tvā | sukhe | rathe | vahatāṃ | iṃdra | keśinā |*
> *ghṛtasnū iti ghṛtasnū | barhiḥ | āsade ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र घृतस्नू श्रमजनितजलप्रस्रवणयुक्तौ केशिना केशिनौ स्कंधप्रदेशे
> लंबमानकेशयुक्तौ हरी आसद आसदनीयं बर्हिरभिलक्ष्य सुखे सुखकरे रथेऽर्वांच
> मस्तदभिमुखं त्वा त्वां वहतां ॥ अर्वांचं । अंचतेः क्विन्युगिदचामिति
> नुम् । वहतां । वहेर्लोटि रूपं । तसो लसार्वधातुकस्वरे कृते धातुस्वरः ।
> आसदे । सदेः कृत्यार्थे केन्प्रत्ययः । नित्सरः । कृदुत्तरपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra ghṛtasnū śramajanitajalaprasravaṇayuktau keśinā keśinau skaṃdhapradeśe*
> *laṃbamānakeśayuktau harī āsada āsadanīyaṃ barhirabhilakṣya sukhe sukhakare rathe 'rvāṃca mastadabhimukhaṃ tvā tvāṃ vahatāṃ ‖ arvāṃcaṃ | aṃcateḥ kvinyugidacāmiti*
> *num | vahatāṃ | vaherloṭi rūpaṃ | taso lasārvadhātukasvare kṛte dhātusvaraḥ |*
> *āsade | sadeḥ kṛtyārthe kenpratyayaḥ | nitsaraḥ | kṛduttarapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, let your two horses, घृतस्नू (*ghṛtasnū*), which have a flow of water produced by exertion, and केशिना (*keśinā*), which have hair hanging down on the shoulder region, bring you (वहतां (*vahatāṃ*)) facing us (अर्वांचं (*arvāṃcaṃ*)), in the comfortable chariot, toward the grass-seat (बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)) on which one is to sit (आसदे (*āsade*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- धृतस्नू (*dhṛtasnū*)—your horses with bodies shining like ghee (or covered with sweat)[?18]
- केशिना (*keśinā*)—with attractive hair on the neck
- आसदे (*āsade*)—fit for sitting
- बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)—toward the seat of darbha grass
- सुखे (*sukhe*)—comfortable
- रथे (*rathe*)—in the chariot
- अर्वांचं (*arvāṃcaṃ*)—facing us
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- वहतां (*vahatāṃ*)—let them bring

Gist

O Indra, let your horses, with bodies shining like ghee (or covered with sweat) and with attractive hair on the neck, bring you facing us in the comfortable chariot toward the darbha-grass seat fit for sitting.

English translation

May your long-maned and sleek-coated steeds bring you down in your easy chariot to sit upon the sacred grass.

Special Topics

धृतस्नू (*dhṛtasnū*)—श्रमजनितजलप्रस्रवणयुक्तौ (*śramajanitajalaprasravaṇayuktau*). Since the word dhṛta is read among the names of water (Ni. 2-24), dhṛta means water, the water of exertion, that is, sweat. Because horses run fast over a long distance, their bodies are soaked with sweat. In the same way here, because Indra's horses have brought Indra from far away to our place of sacrifice, their bodies are drenched with sweat. That condition is described here by the word धृतस्नू (*dhṛtasnū*).?[19]

केशिना (*keśinā*)—केशिनौ । स्कंधप्रदेशे लंबमानकेशयुक्तौ हरी । (*keśinau | skaṃdhapradeśe laṃbamānakeśayuktau harī* |) It is natural for horses to have long hair on the neck. In the same way, Indra's horses are described here as having long hair on the neck.

Sūkta 42 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> उप नः सुतमिति नवर्चं चतुर्थं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं गायत्रमैंद्रं । उप
> न इत्यनुक्रमणिका । पूर्वसूक्तेन सहोक्तो विनियोगः ॥

> *upa naḥ sutamiti navarcaṃ caturthaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ*
> *gāyatramaiṃdraṃ | upa*
> *na ityanukramaṇikā | pūrvasūktena sahokto viniyogaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The fourth sūkta, of nine Ṛks, beginning उप नः सुतं (*upa naḥ sutaṃ*), has Viśvāmitra as seer, is in the Gāyatrī metre and is addressed to Indra. The Anukramaṇikā (index) begins it with उप न (*upa na*). Its viniyoga (ritual use) is the one stated together with the previous sūkta.

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning उप नः सुतं (*upa naḥ sutaṃ*) is the fourth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka. It has nine Ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, its deity Indra, its metre Gāyatrī. The Anukramaṇikā begins it with उप नः (*upa naḥ*). Its viniyoga was stated at the beginning of the previous sūkta.

Sūkta—42

Maṇḍala—3 · Anuvāka—4 · Sūkta—42

Aṣṭaka—3 · Adhyāya—3 · Varga—5, 6

Number of Ṛks in the sūkta—9

Ṛṣi—Viśvāmitra

Devatā—Indra

Chandas—Gāyatrī

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उप॑ नः सु॒तमा ग॑हि॒ सोम॑मिन्द्र॒ गवा॑शिरम् ।
हरि॑भ्यां॒ यस्ते॑ अस्म॒युः ॥ १ ॥

> *upa naḥ sutamā gahi somamindra gavāśiram |*
> *haribhyāṃ yaste asmayuḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उप । नः । सुतं । आ । गहि । सोमं । इंद्र । गोऽआशिरं ।
> हरिभ्यां । यः । ते । अस्मयुः ॥ १ ॥

> *upa | naḥ | sutaṃ | ā | gahi | somaṃ | iṃdra | go 'āśiraṃ |*
> *haribhyāṃ | yaḥ | te | asmayuḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र नोऽस्मदीयं सुतमभिषुतं गवाशिरं पयसा मिश्रितं सोमं प्रति
> उपा गहि । समीप आगच्छ । यतो हरिभ्यामश्वाभ्यां युक्तस्तव रथोऽस्मयुरस्मा–

> *he iṃdra no 'smadīyaṃ sutamabhiṣutaṃ gavāśiraṃ payasā miśritaṃ somaṃ prati*
> *upā gahi | samīpa āgaccha | yato haribhyāmaśvābhyāṃ yuktastava ratho 'smayurasmā-*

> स्कामयमानो वर्तते ॥ गवाशिरं । आज् पूर्वस्य श्रीणातेः
> क्विप्यपस्पृधेथामान्यचुरित्यादिनाशिरित्यादेशः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *skāmayamāno vartate ‖ gavāśiraṃ | āj pūrvasya śrīṇāteḥ*
> *kvipyapaspṛdhethāmānyacurityādināśirityādeśaḥ | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, come near to our pressed (सुतं (*sutaṃ*)) Soma, mixed with milk (गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*)), since your chariot, yoked with two horses, is desirous of us (अस्मयुः (*asmayuḥ*), "wishing us").

The remainder of the block gives only the derivation of गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*), with the substitution āśir for the root śrīṇāti after ā-√ac, and its accent; this belongs to grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—by us
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*)—mixed with milk
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—toward the Soma juice
- उप आ गहि (*upa ā gahi*)—graciously come near
- हरिभ्यां (*haribhyāṃ*)—joined with horses
- ते (*te*)—your
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the chariot that there is
- आस्मयुः (*āsmayuḥ*)—is favourable toward us

Gist

O Indra, come near toward the Soma juice pressed by us and mixed with milk. Your chariot, joined with horses, is favourable toward us.

English translation

Come, Indra, to this our effused Soma juice mixed with milk and curds, with your horses (yoked to your car), which is favourably disposed to us.

Special Topics

सुतं आ गहि (*sutaṃ ā gahi*)—toward the Soma juice that we have prepared; that is, the idea is "come near us to drink Soma."

गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*)—पयसा मिश्रितं सोमं । (*payasā miśritaṃ somaṃ* |) It is the custom to mix milk, curds and wheat flour into the Soma juice to make it tasty. Soma juice mixed with milk is called gavāśira, Soma juice mixed with curds is called dadhyāśira, and Soma juice mixed with flour is called yavāśira. For these āśira substances, see what we have written in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 2, page 172.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तमि॑न्द्र॒ मद॒मा ग॑हि बर्हि॒ःष्ठां ग्राव॑भिः सु॒तम् ।
कु॒विन्न्व॑स्य तृ॒प्णव॑ः ॥ २ ॥

> *tamindra madamā gahi barhiḥṣṭhāṃ grāvabhiḥ sutam |*
> *kuvinnvasya tṛpṇavaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । इंद्र । मदं । आ । गहि । बर्हिःस्थां । ग्रावभिः । सुतं ।
> कुवित् । नु । अस्य । तृप्नवः ॥ २ ॥

> *taṃ | iṃdra | madaṃ | ā | gahi | barhiḥsthāṃ | grāvabhiḥ | sutaṃ |*
> *kuvit | nu | asya | tṛpnavaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र ग्रावभिः सुतमभिषुतं बर्हिष्ठां बर्हिषि स्थितं मदं । मद्यतेऽनेनेति मदः सोमः । तमिमं सोममा गहि । आगच्छ । कुवित्प्रभूतं यथा भवति
> तथास्य सोमस्य पाने नु क्षिप्रं तृप्नवः । तृप्तो भव ॥ मदं । मदी हर्षे ।
> मदोनुपसर्ग इत्यप्प्रत्ययः । तस्य पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । बर्हिष्ठां ।
> ष्ठा गतिनिवृत्तौ । क्विप् । संहितायां पूर्वपदसकारस्यादेशप्रत्यययोरिति षत्वं ।
> ष्टुत्वं । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । तृप्नवः । तृप प्रीणन इत्यस्य लेट्यडागमः । कुविद्योगादनिघातः ।
> कुभ्नादिषु नृनमन तृप्नोतीति पठितं । तथापि सर्वविधीनां छंदसि विकल्पितत्पादत्र
> णत्वप्रतिषेधो न भवति । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra grāvabhiḥ sutamabhiṣutaṃ barhiṣṭhāṃ barhiṣi sthitaṃ madaṃ | madyate 'neneti madaḥ somaḥ | tamimaṃ somamā gahi | āgaccha | kuvitprabhūtaṃ yathā bhavati*
> *tathāsya somasya pāne nu kṣipraṃ tṛpnavaḥ | tṛpto bhava ‖ madaṃ | madī harṣe |*
> *madonupasarga ityappatyayaḥ | tasya pitvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | barhiṣṭhāṃ |*
> *ṣṭhā gatinivṛttau | kvip | saṃhitāyāṃ pūrvapadasakārasyādeśapratyayayoriti ṣatvaṃ |*
> *ṣṭutvaṃ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | tṛpnavaḥ | tṛpa prīṇana ityasya*

> *leṭyaḍāgamaḥ | kuvidyogādanighātaḥ | kubhnādiṣu nṛnamana tṛpnotīti paṭhitaṃ | tathāpi sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi vikalpitatpādatra ṇatvapratiṣedho na bhavati | pratyayasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, this Soma, pressed out with the pressing stones and lying on the sacred grass, is the exhilarating (मदं (*madaṃ*)) drink; Soma is called मदः (*madaḥ*) because by it one is gladdened. Sāyaṇa asks Indra to come to this Soma. कुवित् (*kuvit*) means "abundantly": as there is abundance, may Indra quickly (नु (*nu*)) become satisfied in drinking this Soma.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- ग्रावभिः (*grāvabhiḥ*)—by the pressing stones
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed out
- बर्हिष्ठां (*barhiṣṭhāṃ*)—placed upon the darbha seats
- मदं (*madaṃ*)—and gladdening
- तं (*taṃ*)—this
- Soma juice: toward it
- आ गहि (*ā gahi*)—be pleased to come
- कुवित् (*kuvit*)—abundant
- अस्य (*asya*)—by drinking this juice
- नु (*nu*)—quickly
- तृष्णवः (*tṛṣṇavaḥ*)—attain satisfaction

Gist

O Indra, be pleased to come toward this Soma juice, pressed by the pressing stones, placed upon the darbha seats and gladdening. Quickly attain satisfaction by drinking this abundant juice.

English translation

Come, Indra, to the exhilarating (Soma) expressed by the stones, and placed upon the sacred grass : drink of it to satiety, for there is plenty.

Special Topics

बर्हिष्ठां ग्रावभिः सुतं (*barhiṣṭhāṃ grāvabhiḥ sutaṃ*)—The Soma juice, crushed, pressed and filtered with stones, is placed upon the spread darbha grass called barhis. Indra is prayed to come to drink it.

नु (*nu*)—Although the particle नु (*nu*) has many meanings, the commentator here takes the meaning क्षिप्रं (*kṣipraṃ*), "quickly", and explains accordingly.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑मि॒त्था गिरो॒ ममाच्छा॑गुरिषि॒ता इ॒तः ।
आ॒वृते॒ सोम॑पीतये ॥ ३ ॥

> *indramitthā giro mamācchāguriṣitā itaḥ |*
> *āvṛte somapītaye ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रं । इत्था । गिरः । मम । अच्छ । अगुः । इषिताः । इतः ।
> आवृते । सोमपीतये ॥ ३ ॥

> *iṃdraṃ | itthā | giraḥ | mama | accha | aguḥ | iṣitāḥ | itaḥ |*
> *āvṛte | somapītaye ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र इषितास्त्यदर्थं प्रेरिता इत्येत्थमनेन प्रकारेणोच्यमाना मम
> गिरः स्तुतिलक्षणा वाच इंद्रं त्वामितोऽस्माद्देवयजनदेशादच्छागुः । अभिमुख्येन
> गच्छंतु । किमर्थं । सोमपीतये सोमपानार्थमावृते त्वामावर्तयितुं ॥
> इत्था । इदंशब्दात्था हेत् च छंदसीति व्यत्ययेन थाप्रत्ययः । इदम एतेत् रथोरितीदित्यादेशः
> । प्रत्ययस्वरः । अच्छ । अच्छ गत्यर्थवदेष्विति गतिसंज्ञा । अगुः । इण्
> गतावित्यस्य लुङि रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *he iṃdra iṣitāstyadarthaṃ preritā ityetthamanena prakāreṇocyamānā mama*
> *giraḥ stutilakṣaṇā vāca iṃdraṃ tvāmito 'smāddevayajanadeśādacchāguḥ*

> *| abhimukhyena*
> *gacchaṃtu | kimarthaṃ | somapītaye somapānārthamāvṛte*
> *tvāmāvartayituṃ ‖*
> *itthā | idaṃśabdātthā het ca chaṃdasīti vyatyayena thāpratyayaḥ |*
> *idama etet rathoritīdityādeśaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | accha | accha*
> *gatyarthavadeṣṭiti gatisaṃjñā | aguḥ | iṇ*
> *gatāvityasya luṅi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, my praises, which are impelled (इषिताः (*iṣitāḥ*)) toward you and are thus recited, are to go from this place of the sacrifice toward you, Indra, face to face. For what purpose? For drinking Soma, आवृते (*āvṛte*), that is, to bring you here.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- इषुताः (*iṣutāḥ*)—impelled toward you
- इत्था (*itthā*)—recited in this manner
- मम (*mama*)—my
- गिरः (*giraḥ*)—words in the form of praise
- सोमपीतये (*somapītaye*)—for the drinking of Soma
- आवृते (*āvṛte*)—to bring you here
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—you, who are Indra
- आच्छागुः (*ācchāguḥ*)—let them set out toward

Gist

O Indra, may my words of praise, impelled toward you and recited in this manner, set out toward you, who are Indra, in order to bring you here for the drinking of Soma.

English translation

May my praises, addressed from hence and in this manner, attain Iudra, to bring him hither to drink the Soma juice

Special Topics

अच्छ (*accha*)—आभिमुख्येन (*ābhimukhyena*), "facing toward". Yāska, giving the derivation of the word अच्छ (*accha*), says अच्छाभेराप्तुमिति शाकपूणिः (*acchābherāptumiti śākapūṇiḥ*) (Ni. 5-28): it is the view of Śākapūṇi that the word अच्छ (*accha*) means "facing, coming to meet".

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ं सोम॑स्य पी॒तये॒ स्तोमै॑रि॒ह ह॑वामहे ।
उ॒क्थेभि॑◌ः कु॒विदा॒गम॑त् ॥ ४ ॥

> *indraṃ somasya pītaye stomairiha havāmahe |*
> *ukthebhiḥ kuvidāgamat ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रं । सोमस्य । पीतये । स्तोमैः । इह । हवामहे ।
> उक्केभिः । कुवित् । आगमत् ॥ ४ ॥

> *iṃdraṃ | somasya | pītaye | stomaiḥ | iha | havāmahe |*
> *ukkebhiḥ | kuvit | āgamat ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोमैस्त्रिवृत्पंचदशादिस्तोमसाध्यः सोत्रैरुक्षेभिरुक्षे शस्त्रैश्चेह
> कर्मणि सोमस्य पीतये सोमपानार्थमिंद्रं हवामहे । वयमाह्वयामः ।
> कविद्भुवारमाहूतः स इंद्र आगमत् । यज्ञं प्रत्यागच्छतु ॥ आगमत् । गमेर्लेट्यडागमः । आगमा
> अनुदात्ता इत्यटोऽनुदात्तत्वाद्धा तुस्वरः । तिजि चोदात्तवतीति
> गतेर्निघातः । कुविद्योगादनिघातः ॥

> *somaistrivṛtpaṃcadaśādistomasādhyaḥ sotrairukṣebhirukṣe*
> *śastraiśceha*
> *karmaṇi somasya pītaye somapānārthamiṃdraṃ havāmahe |*
> *vayamāhvayāmaḥ |*
> *kavidbhuvāramāhūtaḥ sa iṃdra āgamat | yajñaṃ pratyāgacchatu ‖*

> *āgamat | gamerleṭyaḍāgamaḥ | āgamā anudāttā ityaṭo 'nudāttatvāddhā tusvaraḥ | tiji codāttavatīti*
> *gaternighātaḥ | kuvidyogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

With stotras accomplished by the trivṛt, pañcadaśa and other stomas, with ukthas, and with śastras, we invoke Indra in this rite to drink Soma.[?20] Invoked repeatedly (कुवित् (*kuvit*)), may that Indra come, that is, approach the sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- स्तोमैः (*stomaiḥ*)—with praises in the form of stomas
- उक्षेभिः (*ukṣebhiḥ*)—with śastras in the form of ukthas[?21]
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrifice
- सोमस्य (*somasya*)—of the Soma juice
- पीतये (*pītaye*)—for drinking
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- हवामहे (*havāmahe*)—we invoke
- कुपित् (*kupit*)—Indra, invoked many times[?22]
- आगमत् (*āgamat*)—may he come to this place of sacrifice

Gist

With praises in the form of stomas and with śastra-mantras in the form of ukthas[?23] we invoke Indra in this sacrifice to drink the Soma juice. May Indra, who is invoked many times, come to this place of sacrifice.

English translation

We invoke Indra to this rite with prayers to drink the Soma juice; may he, repeatedly invoked, come hither

Special Topics

कुवित् (*kuvit*)—Since the word कुवित् (*kuvit*) is read among the twelve words for "much", such as उरु (*uru*) and तुवि (*tuvi*) (Ni. 3-13), it means "many times, abundantly".

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ सोमा॑ः सु॒ता इ॒मे तान्द॑धिष्व शतक्रतो ।
ज॒ठरे॑ वाजिनीवसो ॥ ५ ॥

> *indra somāḥ sutā ime tāndadhiṣva śatakrato |*
> *jaṭhare vājinīvaso ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । सोमाः । सुताः । इमे । तान् । दधिष्व । शतक्रतो इति शतक्रतो ।
> जठरे । वाजिनीवसो इति वाजिनीवसो ॥ ५ ॥

> *iṃdra | somāḥ | sutāḥ | ime | tān | dadhiṣva | śatakrato iti śatakrato |*
> *jaṭhare | vājinīvaso iti vājinīvaso ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे शतक्रतो इंद्र इमे सोमाः सुताः । ग्रावभिस्त्वदर्थमभिषुताः । हे
> वाजिनीवसो अन्नधन । यद्वा । वाजोऽन्नमासु फलत्वेनास्तीति वाजिन्यः क्रियाः ।
> तासां वासक हे इंद्र तान्सोमरसान् जठरे दधिष्ट । धारय ॥ वाजिनीवसो ।
> वाजशब्दान्मत्वर्थेऽत इनिरनावितीनिप्रत्ययः । ऋन्नेभ्यो जीबिति जीप् । तासां
> वसो । संबुद्धौ चेति गुणः । आमंत्रितत्वादाष्टमिकमनुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *he śatakrato iṃdra ime somāḥ sutāḥ | grāvabhistvadarthamabhiṣutāḥ | he*
> *vājinīvaso annadhana | yadvā | vājo 'nnamāsu phalatvenāstīti vājinyaḥ kriyāḥ |*
> *tāsāṃ vāsaka he iṃdra tānsomarasān jaṭhare dadhiṣṭa | dhāraya ‖ vājinīvaso |*
> *vājaśabdānmatvarthe 'ta iniranāvitīnipratyayaḥ | ṛnnebhyo jībiti jīp | tāsāṃ*
> *vaso | saṃbuddhau ceti guṇaḥ | āmaṃtritatvādāṣṭamikamanudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Indra of a hundred acts, these Soma juices are pressed; they have been pressed out with the stones for you. O वाजिनीवसो (*vājinīvaso*), one whose wealth is food. Or else: वाज (*vāja*) is food, and वाजिन्यः (*vājinyaḥ*) are the rites which have food as their fruit; Indra is the dweller (वासक (*vāsaka*)) in them. O Indra, hold those Soma juices in your belly.

Word-to-word meaning

- शतक्रतो (*śatakrato*)—O doer of many deeds of valour
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- इमे सोमाः (*ime somāḥ*)—these Soma juices
- सुताः (*sutāḥ*)—are pressed
- वाजिनीवसो (*vājinīvaso*)—O Indra, whose wealth is food
- तान् (*tān*)—these Soma juices
- जठरे (*jaṭhare*)—in the belly
- दधिष्व (*dadhiṣva*)—hold

Gist

O Indra, doer of many deeds of valour, these Soma juices have been pressed and are ready. O Indra, whose wealth is food, hold these Soma juices in your belly.

English translation

Indra, these Soma juices are poured out : take them, Shatakratu, into your stomach ; you who are rich in (abundant) food

Special Topics

शतक्रतो (*śatakrato*)—शत (*śata*) means hundreds, many; क्रतु (*kratu*) means act. The word means: O Indra, who have performed many deeds of valour.

अन्नवे धन (*annave dhana*)… वाजिनीवसो (*vājinīvaso*)—One whose wealth is food, that is, one who has abundant food. Or else, वाज (*vāja*) means food, and वाजिनी (*vājinī*) means rites such as sacrifices that have food as their fruit. Because he dwells in such rites, that is, because he is praised in such sacrifices, Indra is named वाजिनीवसु (*vājinīvasu*). Thus the commentator explains two meanings.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि॒द्मा हि त्वा॑ धनंज॒यं वाजे॑षु दधृ॒षं क॑वे ।
अधा॑ ते सु॒म्नमी॑महे ॥ ६ ॥

> *vidmā hi tvā dhanaṃjayaṃ vājeṣu dadhṛṣaṃ kave |*
> *adhā te sumnamīmahe ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विद्म । हि । त्वा । धनंजयं । वाजेषु ' दधृषं । कवे ।
> अध । ते । सुम्मं । ईमहे ॥ ६ ॥

> *vidma | hi | tvā | dhanaṃjayaṃ | vājeṣu ' dadhṛṣaṃ | kave |*
> *adha | te | summaṃ | īmahe ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे कवे क्रांतदर्शिन्निंद्र वाजेषु युद्धेषु दधृषं शत्रूणामभिभवितारं
> आत एव धनंजयं । धनं जयतीति धनंजयः । तादृशं त्वा त्वां विद्म हि । जानीमः
> खलु । अधानंतरं ते तव सुम्मं धनमीमहे । याचामहे ॥ विद्म । विदेर्लटि
> विदो लटो वेति मसो मादेशः । पादादित्पादनिघातः । धनंजयं । जि जय इत्यस्माद्धन
> उपपदे संज्ञायां भृत्यवृजिधारिसहितपिदम इति खच् प्रत्ययः । अरुर्द्विपदजंतस्य मुमिति
> पूर्वपदस्य मुमागमः । चित्तादंतोदात्तः । दधृषं । इद्धृषा
> प्रागल्ब इत्यस्य यज् लुक्यभ्यासस्य रीगभावश्छांदसः । तदंतात्पचाद्यचि यजोऽचि
> चेति यजो लुक् । लघूपधगुणे प्राप्ते न धातुलोप इति तस्य प्रतिषेधः ।
> चित्तादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *he kave krāṃtadarśinniṃdra vājeṣu yuddheṣu dadhṛṣaṃ*
> *śatrūṇāmabhibhavitāraṃ*
> *āta eva dhanaṃjayaṃ | dhanaṃ jayatīti dhanaṃjayaḥ | tādṛśaṃ tvā*
> *tvāṃ vidma hi | jānīmaḥ*
> *khalu | adhānaṃtaraṃ te tava summaṃ dhanamīmahe | yācāmahe ‖*

> *vidma | viderlaṭi*
> *vido laṭo veti maso mādeśaḥ | pādāditpādanighātaḥ | dhanaṃjayaṃ | ji*
> *jaya ityasmāddhana upapade saṃjñāyāṃ bhṛtyavṛjidhārisahitapidama*
> *iti khac pratyayaḥ | arurdvipadajaṃtasya mumiti pūrvapadasya*
> *mumāgamaḥ | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | dadhṛṣaṃ | iddhṛṣā*
> *prāgalba ityasya yaj lukyabhyāsasya rīgabhāvaścāṃdasaḥ |*
> *tadaṃtātpacādyaci yajo 'ci*
> *ceti yajo luk | laghūpadhaguṇe prāpte na dhātulopa iti tasya pratiṣedhaḥ |*
> *cittādaṃtodāttaḥ ||*

Summary

O far-seeing (कवे (*kave*)) Indra, in battles (वाजेषु (*vājeṣu*)) you overcome enemies, and therefore you are धनंजयं (*dhanaṃjayaṃ*), "winner of wealth", one who wins wealth. We know you to be such. Thereafter we ask, beg, for सुम्मं (*summaṃ*), your wealth.

Word-to-word meaning

- कवे (*kave*)—O far-seeing Indra
- वाजेषु (*vājeṣu*)—in battles
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- दधृषं (*dadhṛṣaṃ*)—as the destroyer of enemies
- धनंजयं (*dhanaṃjayaṃ*)—and as the gatherer of the enemies' wealth
- विद्म हि (*vidma hi*)—we indeed know
- अध (*adha*)—therefore
- ते (*te*)—your (from you)
- सुम्नं (*sumnaṃ*)—wealth (happiness)[?24]
- ईमहे (*īmahe*)—we pray for

Gist

O far-seeing Indra, in battles we know you indeed as the destroyer of enemies and the gatherer of the enemies' wealth. Therefore we pray for your wealth.

English translation

Far-seeing Indra, we know you to be victorious and winner of wealth in battles: therefore we ask of you riches.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the final letters of the words विद्म (*vidma*) and अध (*adha*) are long in the Saṃhitā-pāṭha for the convenience of the metre.

वाजेषु दधृषं (*vājeṣu dadhṛṣaṃ*)—The word वाजः (*vājaḥ*) is read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9) and also among the names of battle (Ni. 3-9). Here the commentator takes the meaning battle or war, and explains: one who overcomes enemies in battles.

धनंजयं (*dhanaṃjayaṃ*)—Indra, who defeats enemies in battles and wins their wealth.

सुम्नं (*summaṃ*)—Since the word सुम्नं (*summaṃ*) is read among the names of happiness (Ni. 3-13), it means happiness.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒ममिं॑न्द्र॒ गवा॑शिरं॒ यवा॑शिरं च नः पिब ।
आ॒गत्या॒ वृष॑भिः सु॒तम् ॥ ७ ॥

> *imamindra gavāśiraṃ yavāśiraṃ ca naḥ piba |*
> *āgatyā vṛṣabhiḥ sutam ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमं । इंद्र । गोऽआशिरं । यवऽआशिरं । च । नः । पिब ।
> आगत्य । वृषभिः । सुतं ॥ ७ ॥

> *imaṃ | iṃdra | go 'āśiraṃ | yava 'āśiraṃ | ca | naḥ | piba |*
> *āgatya | vṛṣabhiḥ | sutaṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र गवाशिरं गव्यमिश्रणोपेतं सोमं तथा यवाशिरं यवमिश्रणोपेतं वृषभिग्रावभिः सुतमभिषुतं
> नोऽस्मदीयमिमं सोमं देवयजनमागत्य
> पिब ॥ गवाशिरं यवाशिरमित्यत्र आज् पूर्वस्य श्रीणातेः क्विप्यपस्पृधेथा
> मान्यचुरित्यादिनाशिरित्यादेशः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra gavāśiraṃ gavyamiśraṇopetaṃ somaṃ tathā yavāśiraṃ*
> *yavamiśraṇopetaṃ vṛṣabhigrāvabhiḥ sutamabhiṣutaṃ no*
> *'smadīyamimaṃ somaṃ devayajanamāgatya*
> *piba ‖ gavāśiraṃ yavāśiramityatra āj pūrvasya śrīṇāteḥ*
> *kvipyapaspṛdhethā mānyacurityādināśirityādeśaḥ | bahuvrīhau*
> *pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, come to the place of sacrifice and drink this Soma of ours, which is गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*), mixed with milk products, and यवाशिरं (*yavāśiraṃ*), mixed with barley, pressed out with the stones.[?25]

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*)—that which is mixed with milk products
- यवाशिरं (*yavāśiraṃ*)—that which is well prepared with barley grain
- वृषभिः (*vṛṣabhiḥ*)—by the pressing stones
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—and pressed
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- इमं (*imaṃ*)—for this Soma-drinking
- आगत्य (*āgatya*)—having come here
- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, come here and drink this Soma of ours, which is mixed with milk products, mixed with barley grain, and pressed by the pressing stones.

English translation

Having come (to our rite) drink, Indra, this our (libation), effused by the stones, and mixed with milk and curds and with barley.

Special Topics

वृषभीः सुतं (*vṛṣabhīḥ sutaṃ*) means ग्रावभिः अभिषुतं (*grāvabhiḥ abhiṣutaṃ*): the Soma juice taken out by crushing the Soma plants with stones. We have already explained the meaning of the words गवाशिरं (*gavāśiraṃ*) and यवाशिरं (*yavāśiraṃ*) in the special topics of the first Ṛk of this sūkta.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तुभ्येदिं॑न्द्र॒ स्व ओ॒क्ये॒३॒॑ सोमं॑ चोदामि पी॒तयें॑ ।
ए॒ष रा॑रन्तु ते हृ॒दि ॥ ८ ॥

> *tubhyedindra sva okye somaṃ codāmi pītaye |*
> *eṣa rārantu te hṛdi ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुभ्य । इत् ! इंद्र । स्वे । ओक्ये । सोमं । चोदामि । पीतये ।
> एषः । ररंतु । ते । हृदि ॥ ८ ॥

> *śubhya | it ! iṃdra | sve | okye | somaṃ | codāmi | pītaye |*
> *eṣaḥ | raraṃtu | te | hṛdi ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र तुभ्येत्तुभ्यमेव पीतये पानार्थं स्वे स्वकीय ओक्ये स्थाने जठरेऽभिषुतमिमं सोमं चोदामि । प्रेरयामि । एष पीतः सोमस्ते तव हृदि
> हृदये ररंतु । अत्यर्थं रमतां ॥ तुभ्य । युष्मच्छब्दस्य चतुर्थ्येकवचने तुभ्यमह्याविति तुभ्यादेशः । सुपां सुलुगिति सुपो लुक् । जयि चेत्याद्युदात्तः । ओक्ये ।

> *he iṃdra tubhyettubhyameva pītaye pānārthaṃ sve svakīya okye sthāne jaṭhare 'bhiṣutamimaṃ somaṃ codāmi | prerayāmi | eṣa pītaḥ somaste tava hṛdi*

> *hṛdaye raraṃtu | atyarthaṃ ramatāṃ ‖ tubhya | yuṣmacchabdasya caturthyekavacane tubhyamahyāviti tubhyādeśaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti supo luk | jayi cetyādyudāttaḥ | okye |*

> वस्वादित्वात्स्वार्थिको यत्प त्ययः । तित्स्वरितः । चोदामि । चुद प्रेरणे । ण्यंतस्य
> लटि रूपं । बहुलमन्यत्रापीति णेर्लुक् । निघातः । रारंतु । रमु क्रीडायामित्यस्य
> यज् लुकि लोटि सर्वविधीनां छंदसि विकल्पितत्वादत्राभ्यासस्य नुमभावः।
> संहितायामान्येषामपीत्यभ्यासस्य दीर्घः । निघातः । हृदि । हृदयशब्दस्य
> पद्दन्नोमास्मृदित्यादिना हृदादेशः । ऊडिदमिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *vasvāditvātsvārthiko yatpa tyayaḥ | titsvaritaḥ | codāmi | cuda preraṇe | ṇyaṃtasya*
> *laṭi rūpaṃ | bahulamanyatrāpīti ṇerluk | nighātaḥ | rāraṃtu | ramu krīḍāyāmityasya*
> *yaj luki loṭi sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi vikalpitatvādatrābhyāsasya numabhāvaḥ| saṃhitāyāmānyeṣāmapītyabhyāsasya dīrghaḥ | nighātaḥ | hṛdi | hṛdayaśabdasya paddannomāsmṛdityādinā hṛdādeśaḥ | ūḍidamiti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, for you alone, for drinking, in your own abode, in the belly, I urge this pressed Soma." So Sāyaṇa glosses: चोदामि (*codāmi*) is "I impel". "May this Soma, once drunk, delight exceedingly in your heart" is his gloss of ररंतु (*raraṃtu*). The rest of the block, which begins with the word तुभ्य (*tubhya*), is grammatical.

This part of the block contains only grammatical analysis of the words ओक्ये (*okye*), चोदामि (*codāmi*), रारंतु (*rāraṃtu*) and हृदि (*hṛdi*) (affixes, elisions, accent); the Grammar section is not given here.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- तुभ्येत् (*tubhyet*)—with you alone in view
- पीतये (*pītaye*)—for your drinking
- स्वे (*sve*)—your own
- ओक्ये (*okye*)—in the place that is the belly
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—this Soma
- चोदामि (*codāmi*)—I offer

- एषः (*eṣaḥ*)—this Soma
- ते (*te*)—your
- हृदि (*hṛdi*)—in the heart
- ररंतु (*raraṃtu*)—let it cause delight

Gist

O Indra, with you alone in view, for your drinking, I offer this Soma in your own place, the belly. May this Soma cause delight in your heart.

English translation

I offer to you, Indra, this Soma juice for your drinking, to be taken into its proper receptacle ; may it delight your heart.

Special Topics

तुभ्य (*tubhya*) is तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*); here the anusvāra has been dropped for the convenience of the metre. तुभ्य (*tubhya*) + इत् (*it*) = तुभ्येत् (*tubhyet*) means "for you alone".

स्वे ओक्ये (*sve okye*): Yāska has given the etymological explanation ओक इति निवासनामोच्यते (*oka iti nivāsanāmocyate*), that is, that ओक (*oka*) is a name for a dwelling-place. Here स्वे ओक्ये (*sve okye*) means "in one's own dwelling-place", or "in one's own belly".

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वां सु॒तस्य॑ पी॒तये॑ प्र॒त्नमि॑न्द्र हवामहे ।
कु॒शि॒कासो॑ अव॒स्यव॑ः ॥ ९ ॥

> *tvāṃ sutasya pītaye pratnamindra havāmahe |*
> *kuśikāso avasyavaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वां । सुतस्य । पीतये । प्रत्नं । इंद्र । हनामहे ।
> कुतिकासः । अवस्यवः ॥ ९ ॥

> *tvāṃ | sutasya | pītaye | pratnaṃ | iṃdra | hanāmahe |*
> *kutikāsaḥ | avasyavaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र अवस्यवस्त्वत्तो रक्षणमिच्छंतः कुशिकासः कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्ना वयं
> सुतस्य ग्रावभिरभिषुतस्य सोमस्य पीतये पानार्थं प्रश्नं पुरातनं त्वां हवामहे ।
> स्तुतिलक्षणाभिर्गिर्भिराह्वयामः ॥ पीतये । स्थागापापचो भाव इति क्विन् ।
> हिष्ठवत्सरतिशत्थांतानां । फि. १–७ । इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं । हवामहे । स्वयत्वेर्लटि बहुलं
> छंदसीति संप्रसारणे रूपं । अवस्यवः । अव इच्छंतीत्यर्थे सुपः क्यच् । क्याछंदसीत्युप्रत्ययः
> । कुशिकासो अवस्यव इत्यत्र संहितायामव्यादवद्यादित्यादिना । पा.
> ६ १–११६ । एजिः प्रकृतिभावः

> *he iṃdra avasyavastvatto rakṣaṇamicchaṃtaḥ kuśikāsaḥ*
> *kuśikagotrotpannā vayaṃ*
> *sutasya grāvabhirabhiṣutasya somasya pītaye pānārthaṃ praśnaṃ*
> *purātanaṃ tvāṃ havāmahe |*
> *stutilakṣaṇābhirgirbhirāhvayāmaḥ ‖ pītaye | sthāgāpāpaco bhāva iti*
> *kvin | hiṣṭhavatsaratiśatthāṃtānāṃ | phi. 1-7 | ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ |*
> *havāmahe | svayatverlaṭi bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe rūpaṃ | avasyavaḥ | ava icchaṃtītyarthe*
> *supaḥ kyac | kyāchaṃdasītyupratyayaḥ | kuśikāso avasyava ityatra*
> *saṃhitāyāmavyādavadyādityādinā | pā.*
> *6 1-116 | ejiḥ prakṛtibhāvaḥ*

Summary

"O Indra, we, born in the Kuśika lineage and desiring protection from you, invoke you, the ancient one, for the drinking of the Soma pressed with the stones; we call you with speech in the form of praise." कुशिकासः (*kuśikāsaḥ*) is explained as "born in the Kuśika gotra", अवस्यवः (*avasyavaḥ*) as "desiring protection", प्रत्नं (*pratnaṃ*) as "ancient", हवामहे (*havāmahe*) as "we call". The rest is grammatical.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- अवस्यवः (*avasyavaḥ*)—we who desire to obtain your protection
- कुशिकासः (*kuśikāsaḥ*)—and who are born in the Kuśika line
- सुतस्य (*sutasya*)—of this pressed Soma juice
- पीतये (*pītaye*)—for the drinking
- प्रत्नं (*pratnaṃ*)—ancient
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- हवामहे (*havāmahe*)—we call with prayer

Gist

O Indra, we who desire to obtain your protection and are born in the Kuśika line call you, the ancient one, with prayer, for the drinking of this pressed Soma juice.

English translation

Descendants of Kusha, desirous of protection, we invoke you, Indra, who are of old, to drink of the libation.

Special Topics

प्रत्नं पुरातनं (*pratnaṃ purātanaṃ*). Since the word प्रत्न (*pratna*) is read among the names of "ancient", "ancient" means "existing from beginningless time".

कुशिकासः (*kuśikāsaḥ*)—कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्ना वयं (*kuśikagotrotpannā vayaṃ*): "we, born in the Kuśika gotra", says the seer Viśvāmitra. On the meaning of the word Kuśika Yāska says: कुशिकस्य सूनुः कुशिको राजा बभूव । क्रोशतेः शब्दकर्मणः । क्रंशतीर्वा स्यात्प्रकाशयति कर्मणः साधुविक्षोशयतार्थानामिति वा ॥ (*kuśikasya sūnuḥ kuśiko rājā babhūva | krośateḥ śabdakarmaṇaḥ | kraṃśatīrvā syātprakāśayati karmaṇaḥ sādhuvikṣośayatārthānāmiti vā* ||) (Ni. 9-25)

Thus he has given the etymological explanation. Kuśika was a king. His descendants are called Kuśikāḥ or Kuśikāsaḥ. The reason why this name came to this king is as follows: the word Kuśika is formed from the root क्रंशति (*kraṃśati*) and gives the sense "making sound". Making sound means uttering words and praising. Therefore the word Kuśikāḥ can also mean people such as priests who praise and recite mantras; or the word Kuśika can be explained as one who makes manifest, that is, who protects, sacrificial rites or the dharmas; or as one who gives artha, that is, wealth and the like, to good people. This is the opinion of the Nirukta authors. In the present Ṛk the word कुशिकासः (*kuśikāsaḥ*) means the seers such as Viśvāmitra, born in the Kuśika gotra.

Sūkta 43 (Maṇḍala 3)

> आ याह्यर्वाज्यात्यष्टर्चं पंचमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभम्यंद्रं ।
> आ याह्यष्टावित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥ दशरात्रे चतुर्थेऽहनि स्तोमवृद्धौ माध्यंदिने
> सवनेऽच्छावाकशस्त्रे स्तोमाभिशंसनार्थमिदं सूक्तं। सूत्रितः च। आ याह्यर्वाज्यात्यष्टर्चान्यावपेरन् । आ ७. १२. । इति ॥ > महाव्रतेऽप्यावपनीयं ॥

> *ā yāhyarvājyātyaṣṭarcaṃ paṃcamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ traiṣṭubhamyaṃdraṃ |*
> *ā yāhyaṣṭāvityanukramaṇikā ‖ daśarātre caturthe 'hani stomavṛddau mādhyaṃdine*
> *savane 'cchāvākaśastre stomābhiśaṃsanārthamidaṃ sūktaṃ| sūtritaḥ ca| ā yāhyarvājyātyaṣṭarcānyāvaperan | ā 7. 12. | iti ‖ > mahāvrate 'pyāvapanīyaṃ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The fifth sūkta, of eight Ṛks, beginning आ याह्यर्वाज् (*ā yāhyarvāj*), is by Viśvāmitra, addressed to Indra, in the Triṣṭubh metre; the Anukramaṇikā says आ याह्यष्टावित्यनुक्रमणिका (*ā yāhyaṣṭāvityanukramaṇikā*). In the Daśarātra, on the fourth day, at the midday pressing, this sūkta is used in the Acchāvāka's śastra for the praise of the stomas, for increase of the stoma. It is also stated in the sūtra आ याह्यर्वाज्यात्यष्टर्चान्यावपेरन् (*ā yāhyarvājyātyaṣṭarcānyāvaperan*) (Ā. 7-12). It is also an insertion hymn in the Mahāvrata.

Anuvāda

The sūkta beginning आ याह्यर्वाज् (*ā yāhyarvāj*) is the fifth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka. It has eight Ṛks. The seer of this sūkta is Viśvāmitra; the deity is Indra; the metre is Triṣṭubh. In the Anukramaṇikā it is introduced with the words आ याह्यष्टौ (*ā yāhyaṣṭau*). In the sacrifice called Daśarātra, on the fourth day, at the midday pressing, for the increase of the stoma, this sūkta is applied (viniyoga) to the śastra mantras that serve the praise of the stoma, to be recited by the priest called Acchāvāka; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra आ याह्यर्वाजित्यष्टर्चान्यावपेरन् (*ā yāhyarvājityaṣṭarcānyāvaperan*) (Ā. 7-12). It is also applied in the sacrifice called Mahāvrata.

Sūkta—43

Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 43.

Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Varga 7.

Number of Ṛks in the sūkta—8.

Seer: Viśvāmitra.

Deity: Indra.

Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ या॑ह्य॒र्वाङुप॑ वन्धु॒रेष्ठास्तवेदनु॑ प्र॒दिव॑◌ः सोम॒पेय॑म् ।
प्रि॒या सखा॑या॒ वि मु॒चोप॑ ब॒र्हिस्त्वामि॒मे ह॑व्य॒वाहो॑ हवन्ते ॥ १ ॥

> *ā yāhyarvāṅupa vandhureṣṭhāstavedanu pradivaḥ somapeyam |*
> *priyā sakhāyā vi mucopa barhistvāmime havyavāho havante ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । याहि । अर्वाज् । उप । वंधुरेऽस्थाः । तव । इत् । अनु । प्रदिवः । सोमपेयं ।
> प्रिया । सखाया । वि । मुच । उप । बर्हिः । त्वां । इमं । हव्यवाहः । हवंते ॥

> *ā | yāhi | arvāj | upa | vaṃdhure 'sthāḥ | tava | it | anu | pradivaḥ | somapeyaṃ |*
> *priyā | sakhāyā | vi | muca | upa | barhiḥ | tvāṃ | imaṃ | havyavāhaḥ | havaṃte ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वंधुरेष्ठाः । वंधुरशब्देनेषाद्वयसंबंधस्थानमभिधीयते ।
> तेन तद्विशिष्टो रथो लक्ष्यते । तस्मिन् रथे तिष्ठन् त्वमर्वाजिस्मदभिमुखः सन् आ
> अभिलक्ष्योप याहि । समीप आगच्छ । प्रदिवः प्रश्नें पूर्वक्रमगतं तवेत्तवैव संबंधि

> सोमपेयं सोमपानं त्वमनु उद्दिश्य प्रिया तव प्रियतम् सखाया समानख्यानावश्च बर्हिरुप
> बर्हिषः समीपॆ: वि मुच । विमुंच । हव्यवाहः । हव्यं
> वहंतीति हव्यवाहः । इमे ऋत्विजस्तां हवंते । सोमपानार्थमाह्वयंति । तस्मादागच्छेति भावः
> ॥ वंधुरेष्ठाः । तिष्ठतेर्विच् । तत्पुरुषे कृति बहुलमिति सप्तम्या
> अलुक् । प्रदिवः । सकारांतमव्ययं । सोमपेयं । पा पान इत्यस्य भावेऽचो
> यदिति यत्पत्ययः । ईद्यतीतीत्वं । अर्धधातुकलक्षणो गुणः। यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> समासे कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । मुच । मंचतेर्लोट्यागमानुशासनसानित्यत्वान्नुमभावः ॥

> *he iṃdra vaṃdhureṣṭhāḥ |*
> *vaṃdhuraśabdeneṣādvayasaṃbaṃdhasthānamabhidhīyate |*
> *tena tadviśiṣṭo ratho lakṣyate | tasmin rathe tiṣṭhan*
> *tvamarvājismadabhimukhaḥ san ā*
> *abhilakṣyopa yāhi | samīpa āgaccha | pradivaḥ praśnèṃ*
> *pūrvakramagataṃ tavettavaiva saṃbaṃdhi*
> *somapeyaṃ somapānaṃ tvamanu uddiśya priyā tava priyatam sakhāyā*
> *samānakhyānāvaśca barhirupa barhiṣaḥ samīpè: vi muca | vimuṃca |*
> *havyavāhaḥ | havyaṃ*
> *vahaṃtīti havyavāhaḥ | ime ṛtvijastāṃ havaṃte |*
> *somapānārthamāhvayaṃti | tasmādāgaccheti bhāvaḥ ‖ vaṃdhureṣṭhāḥ*
> *| tiṣṭhatervic | tatpuruṣe kṛti bahulamiti saptamyā*
> *aluk | pradivaḥ | sakārāṃtamavyayaṃ | somapeyaṃ | pā pāna ityasya*
> *bhāve 'co*
> *yaditi yatpatyayaḥ | īdyatītītvaṃ | ardhadhātukalakṣaṇo guṇaḥ| yato*
> *'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ | samāse kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | muca |*
> *maṃcaterloṭyāgamānuśāsanasānityatvānnumabhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, you who sit in the vandhura! The word vandhura denotes the place where the two shafts join; by it the chariot characterised by it is meant. Standing in that chariot, facing us, come near. Having in view, for your own Soma-drinking that is ancient, belonging to you alone from the earlier course, release your dear, companionable horses near the sacred grass. These oblation-carriers, the priests, call you for the drinking of Soma; therefore come: this is the sense." हव्यवाहः (*havyavāhaḥ*) is explained as "those who carry the oblation". The remainder gives the grammar of वंधुरेष्ठाः (*vaṃdhureṣṭhāḥ*), प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*), सोमपेयं (*somapeyaṃ*) and मुच (*muca*).

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) वंधुरेष्माः (*vaṃdhureṣmāḥ*)—seated in a chariot with an excellent seat
- अर्वाज् (*arvāj*)—and facing us
- आ उप याहि (*ā upa yāhi*)—be pleased to come near us
- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—offered from former times
- तवेत् (*tavet*)—and intended for you alone
- सोमपेयं अनु (*somapeyaṃ anu*)—for the Soma-drinking
- प्रिया (*priyā*)—those dear to you
- सखाया (*sakhāyā*)—and that are together
- (the horses) बर्हिः उप (*barhiḥ upa*)—near the sacred-grass seats
- वि मुंच (*vi muṃca*)—unharness and make stand
- हव्यवाहः (*havyavāhaḥ*)—holding the oblation
- इमे (*ime*)—these priests
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- हवंते (*havaṃte*)—call

Gist

O Indra, seated in a chariot with an excellent seat and facing us, be pleased to come near us. For the Soma-drinking that was offered before all else and is intended for you alone, unharness your dear and companionable horses near the sacred-grass seats and make them stand. These priests, who hold the oblation, call you.

English translation

Descend to us riding in your car, for verily yours is this ancient libation ; unharness your beloved and friendly (horses) near to the sacred grass, for these offerers of the oblation present it to you.

Special Topics

वंधुरेष्ठाः (*vaṃdhureṣṭhāḥ*)—The word वंधुर (*vaṃdhura*) is used as a synonym for the seat of a chariot. But since Sāyaṇa explains it as ईषाद्वयसंबंधस्थान (*īṣādvayasaṃbaṃdhasthāna*), here it can be taken to mean a chariot with a seat made by joining two shafts. Earlier, this word has been used in many places in describing the famous chariot of deities such as the Aśvins; it was explained earlier in places such as अधि वां स्थाम वंधुरे (*adhi vāṃ sthāma vaṃdhure*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-139-4). In places such as रथो यो वां त्रिवंधुरः (*ratho yo vāṃ trivaṃdhuraḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-22-5) too, it means a chariot with three shafts. In the present place it must mean an excellent seat. "One seated in a chariot with an excellent seat" is an epithet of Indra.

प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—प्रत्नं (*pratnaṃ*), प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*) (Ni. 3-19) are read among the names of "ancient". The Nirukta author quotes the Ṛk मरुत्वाइंद्र वृषभो (*marutvāiṃdra vṛṣabho*) and there explains this word as पूर्वेष्टपृहस्सु (*pūrveṣṭapṛhassu*). This means "just like the former days". The sense is that, just as the oblation has been offered from very ancient times, so it is offered even now.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ या॑हि पू॒र्वीरति॑ चर्ष॒णीराँ अ॒र्य आ॒शिष॒ उप॑
नो॒ हरि॑भ्याम् ।
इ॒मा हि त्वा॑ म॒तय॒ः स्तोम॑तष्टा॒ इन्द्र॒ हव॑न्ते स॒
ख्यं जु॑षा॒णाः ॥ २ ॥

> *ā yāhi pūrvīrati carṣaṇīrā~ arya āśiṣa upa no haribhyām |*
> *imā hi tvā matayaḥ stomataṣṭā indra havante sakhyaṃ juṣāṇāḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । याहि । पूर्विः । अति । चर्षणीः । आ । अर्यः । आशिषः । उपे । नः । हरिभ्यां ।
> इमाः । हि । त्वा । मतयः । स्तोमतष्टाः । इंद्र । हवंते । सख्यं । जुषाणाः ॥ २ ॥

> *ā | yāhi | pūrviḥ | ati | carṣaṇīḥ | ā | aryaḥ | āśiṣaḥ | upè | naḥ | haribhyāṃ |*
> *imāḥ | hi | tvā | matayaḥ | stomataṣṭāḥ | iṃdra | havaṃte | sakhyaṃ | juṣāṇāḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र, पूर्वीः सर्वाश्चर्यणीः प्रजा अत्या याहि । अतिक्रम्यागच्छ । द्वितीय
> आज् पूरणः । आर्योऽस्माकं स्वामी त्वं न आशिषस्वमत्रागत्य सोमं पिबेत्येवमादिका
> अस्माकं प्रार्थना हरिभ्यामश्वाभ्यां युक्तः सन् उपागच्छ । किंच ते तव
> सख्यं जुषाणाः सेवमानाः स्तोमतष्टाः स्तोमकारिभिः स्तोतृभिः कृता इमा
> मतयः स्ततयो हवंते । सोमपानार्थं त्वामाह्वयंति । हि प्रसिद्धौ । करणे
> कर्तृव्यापारः । काष्ठानि पचंतीतिवत् ॥ आ । संहितायामाजोऽनुनासिकश्चंदसीत्यनुनासिकः ।
> आर्यः । ऋ गतौ । अर्यः । स्वामिवैश्ययोरिति निपातनाद्यत्पत्ययः ।
> यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वे प्राप्तेऽर्यस्य स्वाम्याख्या चेत् । फि १–१८ । इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं ।
> आशिषः । क्विपि शास इदज् हलोरित्युपधाया इत्वं । शासिवसिघसीनाचेति षत्वं ।
> स्तोमतष्टाः । तक्षू त्वक्षू तनूकरण इत्यस्मात्कर्मणि क्तः । तृतीया
> कर्मणीति पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra, pūrvīḥ sarvāścaryaṇīḥ prajā atyā yāhi | atikramyāgaccha | dvitīya*
> *āj pūraṇaḥ | āryo 'smākaṃ svāmī tvaṃ na āśiṣasvamatrāgatya somaṃ pibetyevamādikā asmākaṃ prārthanā haribhyāmaśvābhyāṃ yuktaḥ san upāgaccha | kiṃca te tava*
> *sakhyaṃ juṣāṇāḥ sevamānāḥ stomataṣṭāḥ stomakāribhiḥ stotṛbhiḥ kṛtā imā*
> *matayaḥ statayo havaṃte | somapānārthaṃ tvāmāhvayaṃti | hi prasiddhau | karaṇe*
> *kartṛvyāpāraḥ | kāṣṭhāni pacaṃtītivat ‖ ā | saṃhitāyāmājo 'nunāsikaścaṃdasītyanunāsikaḥ | āryaḥ | ṛ gatau | aryaḥ | svāmivaiśyayoriti nipātanādyatpatyayaḥ |*
> *yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatve prāpte 'ryasya svāmyākhyā cet | phi 1-18 | ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | āśiṣaḥ | klipi śāsa idaj halorityupadhāyā itvaṃ | śāsivasighasīnāceti ṣatvaṃ | stomataṣṭāḥ | takṣū tvakkū tanūkaraṇa ityasmātkarmaṇi ktaḥ | tṛtīyā*
> *karmaṇīti pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa addresses Indra: "O Indra, pass beyond all the peoples (चर्षणीः (*carṣaṇīḥ*) = prajāḥ) and come to us." Aryaḥ means our lord. "Our prayers (आशिषः (*āśiṣaḥ*)) are of this kind: 'Come here and drink the Soma'. Accepting them, come to us yoked with your two horses." Further, these hymns (मतयः (*matayaḥ*), praises), fashioned by the

praisers, desiring your friendship, invoke you for the drinking of Soma. हि (*hi*) is the well-known particle. The action of the doer is attributed to the instrument, as in "the firewood cooks".[?26]

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- पूर्वीः (*pūrvīḥ*)—all
- चर्षणीः (*carṣaṇīḥ*)—the people
- अति (*ati*)—passing beyond
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—graciously come to us
- अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)—you, the venerable
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- आशिषः (*āśiṣaḥ*)—accepting the prayers
- हरिभ्यां (*haribhyāṃ*)—together with the horses
- उप (*upa*)—come graciously
- सख्यं (*sakhyaṃ*)—your friendship
- जुषाणाः (*juṣāṇāḥ*)—desiring
- स्तोमतष्टाः (*stomataṣṭāḥ*)—fashioned by the praisers
- इमा मतयः (*imā matayaḥ*)—these praises
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- हवंते हि (*havaṃte hi*)—(for the drinking of Soma) call

Gist

O Indra, passing beyond all the peoples, graciously come to us. Venerable one, accept our prayers and come graciously together with your horses. These praises, which desire your friendship and are fashioned by the praisers, call you for the drinking of Soma.

English translation

Passing by multitudes, come hither, noble Indra, with your steeds, (to recive) our benedictions; for these praises, Indra, composed by the devout, invoke you, propitiating your friendship.

Special Topics

चर्षणी (*carṣaṇī*)—The explanation of this word has been given in detail on p. 49 of Part 2 of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā. In many contexts this word means "seer". The meaning "man" is also indicated in many contexts. For words such as चर्षणि (*carṣaṇi*) and कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) the meaning "man" is indicated not directly but through tradition. Even so, this meaning is well known in usage: in places such as Ṛ. Saṃ. 5, 86, 2 : 7, 15, 2; 9, 101, 9, the words पंचचर्षणयः (*paṃcacarṣaṇayaḥ*) and पंचकृष्टयः (*paṃcakṛṣṭayaḥ*) are in use instead of पंचजनाः (*paṃcajanāḥ*). When deities such as Agni and Indra have epithets such as चर्षणीनां पतिः (*carṣaṇīnāṃ patiḥ*) and चर्षणि नां राजा (*carṣaṇi nāṃ rājā*) there is also some breadth of meaning; the special meanings suited to such contexts were stated earlier. But in contexts such as 5-23-4, where this word occurs as an epithet of Agni in विश्वचर्षणिः (*viśvacarṣaṇiḥ*), the meaning "seer of all" is natural. In this way the meaning must be given according to each context.

अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)—This word is read among the names of the Lord, such as राष्ट्री (*rāṣṭrī*) and अरः (*araḥ*) (Ni. 2-22). In this context it is rendered "venerable".

आशिषः (*āśiṣaḥ*)—In common usage the word आशीः (*āśīḥ*) is used in the sense of elders wishing good for the young. But in the Ṛk Saṃhitā it is used in the senses of prayer and desired object. For example, where Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-179-6 says सत्या देवेष्वाशिषो जगाम (*satyā deveṣvāśiṣo jagāma*), the purport is that the sage Agastya obtained all his desired objects. In the same way, in the present Ṛk also the meaning is "our prayers".

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ नो॑ य॒ज्ञं न॑मो॒वृधं॑ स॒जोषा॒ इन्द्र॑ देव॒ हरि॑भिर्याहि॒ तूय॑म् ।
अ॒हं हि त्वा॑ म॒तिभि॒र्जोह॑वीमि घृ॒तप्र॑याः सध॒मादे॒ मधू॑नाम् ॥ ३ ॥

> *ā no yajñaṃ namovṛdhaṃ sajoṣā indra deva haribhiryāhi tūyam |*
> *ahaṃ hi tvā matibhirjohavīmi ghṛtaprayāḥ sadhamāde madhūnām ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । नः । यज्ञं । नमःवृधं । सजोषां । इंद्र । देव । हरिभिः । याहि ।
> तूयं ।
> अहं । हि । त्व । मतिभिः । जोहवीमि । घ्पतप्रयाः । सध्वमादे । मधूनां ॥ ३ ॥

> *ā | naḥ | yajñaṃ | namaḥvṛdhaṃ | sajoṣāṃ | iṃdra | deva | haribhiḥ |*
> *yāhi |*
> *tūyaṃ |*
> *ahaṃ | hi | tva | matibhiḥ | johavīmi | ghptaprayāḥ | sadhvamāde |*
> *madhūnāṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देव द्योतमान हे इंद्र नोऽस्माकं नमोवृधं नमसोन्नस्य वर्धकमिमं यज्ञं हरिभिरश्वैः सजोषाः सहप्रीतिस्त्वं तूयिं क्षिप्रमा याहि । धृतप्रयाः । धृतसहितानि प्रयांस्यन्यरूपाणि हवींषि यस्य स तथोक्तः । तादृशोऽहं मधूनां सेमानां सधमादे । सह माद्यंति यत्र सोम इति सधमादः । तस्मिन् स्थाने मतिभिः स्तुतिभिस्ता त्वां जोहवीमि हि । भृशमाह्वयामि खलु ॥
> जोहवीमि । यज् लुक्यभ्यस्तस्य चेति संप्रसारणं । गुणो यज् लुकोरित्यभ्यासस्य गुणः । यजो वेतीडागमः । हियोगादनिघातः । अभ्यस्तानामादिरित्याद्युदात्तः ।
> धृतप्रयाः । घृ क्षरणदीप्त्योरित्यस्मादंजिघृषिभ्यः क्त इति क्तप्रत्ययः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *deva dyotamāna he iṃdra no 'smākaṃ namovṛdhaṃ namasonnasya vardhakamimaṃ yajñaṃ haribhiraśvaiḥ sajoṣāḥ sahaprītistvaṃ tūyiṃ kṣipramā yāhi | dhṛtaprayāḥ | dhṛtasahitāni prayāṃsyanyarūpāṇi havīṃṣi yasya sa tathoktaḥ | tādṛśo 'haṃ madhūnāṃ semānāṃ sadhamāde | saha mādyaṃti yatra soma iti sadhamādaḥ |*
> *tasmin sthāne matibhiḥ stutibhistā tvāṃ johavīmi hi | bhṛśamāhvayāmi khalu ‖*
> *johavīmi | yaj lukyabhyastasya ceti saṃprasāraṇaṃ | guṇo yaj lukorityabhyāsasya*
> *guṇaḥ | yajo vetīḍāgamaḥ | hiyogādanighātaḥ | abhyastānāmādirityādyudāttaḥ |*
> *dhṛtaprayāḥ | ghṛ kṣaraṇadīptyorityasmādaṃjighṛṣibhyaḥ kta iti ktapratyayaḥ | bahuvrīhau*
> *pūrvapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O shining Indra, with your horses and in accord with us (सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*), with joint pleasure), come quickly to this sacrifice of ours, which increases the food (नमोवृधं (*namovṛdhaṃ*), the augmenter of नमस् (*namas*), food)." घृतप्रयाः (*ghṛtaprayāḥ*) is one whose offerings (prayāṃsi, other forms of oblation) are accompanied by ghee. Being such, "I invoke you vehemently with praises (मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)) in the सधमादे (*sadhamāde*) of the sweet Soma libations." A सधमादः (*sadhamādaḥ*) is the place where they rejoice together over Soma. जोहवीमि (*johavīmi*) means "I call greatly, indeed".

Word-to-word meaning

- देव (*deva*)—shining
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- नमोवृधं (*namovṛdhaṃ*)—food-increasing
- यज्ञं (*yajñaṃ*)—to the sacrifice
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—with the horses
- सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*)—joined with affection
- तूयं (*tūyaṃ*)—quickly
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—come graciously

- घृतप्रयाः (*ghṛtaprayāḥ*)—endowed with oblations accompanied by ghee
- अहं (*ahaṃ*)—I
- मधूनां (*madhūnāṃ*)—of the Soma juices
- सधमादे (*sadhamāde*)—in the place of exhilaration
- मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)—with praises
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- जोहवीमि (*johavīmi*)—I pray and call

Gist

Shining Indra, come quickly and affectionately, with your horses, to our food-increasing sacrifice. I, provided with oblations accompanied by ghee, pray to you and call you with praises in the place of exhilaration of the Soma juice.

English translation

Divine Indra, come quickly with your steeds, and well pleased, to our food-augmenting sacrifice; offering (sacred) food with butter, I invoke you verily with praises in the chamber of the sweet libations.

Special Topics

सधमादे (*sadhamāde*)—The word is formed from the root मद् (*mad*) together with सह (*saha*). It means the region where all, drinking Soma together, find satisfaction. It is an epithet of the sacrificial region, which gives exhilaration to all.

मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)—It has been said in many earlier places that the word मति (*mati*) means speech in the form of praise, and the special meaning of this word has been explained.

नमोवृधं यज्ञं (*namovṛdhaṃ yajñaṃ*)—The meaning is the sacrifice that increases food. The idea well known from the Śruti, यज्ञाद्भवति पर्जन्यः, पर्जन्यादन्नसंभवः (*yajñādbhavati parjanyaḥ, parjanyādannasaṃbhavaḥ*), is expressed here. The sacrifice must cause rain, and through it the wealth of food must increase. The sacrifice is the root of all creation and preservation in the universe. And it is the root not only of the food that man needs but also of the increase of the food-wealth of the gods. As said in sentences such as यज्ञ उ देवानामन्नं (*yajña u devānāmannaṃ*) (Śa. Brā. 8-1-2-10), the sacrifice is also praised as the food of the gods.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ च॒ त्वामे॒ता वृष॑णा॒ वहा॑तो॒ हरी॒ सखा॑या सु॒धु॒रा स्वङ्गा॑ ।
धा॒नाव॒दिन्द्र॒ः सव॑नं जुषा॒णः सखा॒ सख्यु॑ः शृणव॒द्वन्द॑नानि ॥ ४ ॥

> *ā ca tvāmetā vṛṣaṇā vahāto harī sakhāyā sudhurā svaṅgā |*
> *dhānāvadindraḥ savanaṃ juṣāṇaḥ sakhā sakhyuḥ śṛṇavadvandanāni || 4 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । च । त्वां । एता । वृषणा । वहातः । हरी इति । सखाया । सुधुरा । सुअंगा ।
> धानावत् । इंद्रः । सवनं । जुषाणः । सखा । सख्युः । शृणवत् । वंदनानि ॥ ४ ॥

> *ā | ca | tvāṃ | etā | vṛṣaṇā | vahātaḥ | harī iti | sakhāyā | sudhurā | suaṃgā |*
> *dhānāvat | iṃdraḥ | savanaṃ | juṣāṇaḥ | sakhā | sakhyuḥ | śṛṇavat | vaṃdanāni || 4 ||*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वृषणा सेचनसमर्थौ सुधुरा शोभनया धुरान्वितौ स्वंगा शोभनावयवोपेतौ सखाया शोभनाख्यानावेतैतौ हरी त्वामा वहातश्च । यज्ञं
> प्रत्यागमनाय रथे त्वामावहतः । अथ धानावत् भृष्टयवोपेतं सवनं जुषाणः
> सेवमानः सखा सखिभूतः स इंद्रः सख्युः स्तोतुर्मम वंदनानि स्तोत्राणि शृण–

> *he iṃdra vṛṣaṇā secanasamarthau sudhurā śobhanayā dhurānvitau svaṃgā śobhanāvayavopetau sakhāyā śobhanākhyānāvetaitau harī tvāmā vahātaśca | yajñaṃ*

> *pratyāgamanāya rathe tvāmāvahataḥ | atha dhānāvat bhṛṣṭayavopetaṃ savanaṃ juṣāṇaḥ*
> *sevamānaḥ sakhā sakhibhūtaḥ sa iṃdraḥ sakhyuḥ stoturmama vaṃdanāni stotrāṇi śṛṇa-*

> वत् । श्रुयात् ॥ वहातः । वहेर्लेट्याडागमे रूपं । चवायोगे। प्रथमेति न
> निघातः । श्रवणत् । श्रु श्रवण इत्यस्य लेट्यडागमे रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *vat | śruyāt ‖ vahātaḥ | vaherleṭyāḍāgame rūpaṃ | cavāyoge| prathameti na*
> *nighātaḥ | śravaṇat | śru śravaṇa ityasya leṭyaḍāgame rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, these two horses, vigorous (वृषणा (*vṛṣaṇā*), able to sprinkle), well yoked to the pole (सुधुरा (*sudhurā*)), well limbed (स्वंगा (*svaṃgā*)), friendly (सखाया (*sakhāyā*), of good name), bring you in the chariot to come to the sacrifice. Then he, Indra, being a friend, accepting (जुषाणः (*juṣāṇaḥ*)) the sacrifice with parched grain (धानावत् (*dhānāvat*)), may hear (शृणवत् (*śṛṇavat*)) the praises (वंदनानि (*vaṃdanāni*)) of me, his friend (सख्युः (*sakhyuḥ*)), the praiser."

This part of the block gives only grammatical remarks on वहातः (*vahātaḥ*) and श्रवणत् (*śravaṇat*) (the leṭ forms with the augment aṭ) and on accent; the Grammar section carries them.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) वृषणा (*vṛṣaṇā*)—capable of sprinkling
- सुधुरा (*sudhurā*)—able to bear the burden
- स्वंगा (*svaṃgā*)—having excellent limbs
- सखाया (*sakhāyā*)—joined together
- एता हरी (*etā harī*)—these horses (of Indra)
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- आ वहातः (*ā vahātaḥ*)—bring (to the sacrificial region)
- धानावत् (*dhānāvat*)—provided with ripe barley grain
- सवनं (*savanaṃ*)—the sacrifice
- जुषाणः (*juṣāṇaḥ*)—accepting

- सखा (*sakhā*)—being a friend
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—you, in the form of Indra
- सख्युः (*sakhyuḥ*)—of me, your friend
- वंदनासि (*vaṃdanāsi*)—the praises
- शृणवत् च (*śṛṇavat ca*)—be a hearer

Gist

O Indra, these horses, capable of sprinkling, able to bear the burden, having excellent limbs and joined together, bring you to the sacrificial region. You, in the form of Indra, who accept the sacrifice provided with ripe barley grain and are a friend, be a hearer of the praises of me, your friend.

English translation

May these two vigorous friendly burthen-bearing and well-limbed steeds convey you hither, where, Indra, approving of the ceremony (in which the offering) is parched grain, may hear as a friend the praises of his friend (the worshipper)

Special Topics

वंदनानि (*vaṃdanāni*)—In common usage वंदन (*vaṃdana*) means salutation. But in the present context the word is used in the sense of praise. The word is also used in many places as a synonym for disease, demon and the like. For example, in the Ṛks beginning न यातव इंद्र जूजुवुर्नो न वंदना शविष्ठ वेद्याभिः । (*na yātava iṃdra jūjuvurno na vaṃdanā śaviṣṭha vedyābhiḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-21-5) this word means a demon. वंदन (*vaṃdana*) is also a well-known name of a sage.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कु॒विन्मा॑ गो॒पां क॑र॒से जन॑स्य कु॒विद्राजा॑नं मघवन्नृजीषिन् ।
कु॒विन्म॒ ऋषिं॑ पपि॒वांसं॑ सु॒तस्यं॑ कु॒विन्मे॒ वस्वो॑ अ॒मृत॑स्य॒ शिक्षाः॑ ॥ ५ ॥

> *kuvinmā gopāṃ karase janasya kuvidrājānaṃ maghavannṛjīṣin |*
> *kuvinma ṛṣiṃ papivāṃsaṃ sutasya kuvinme vasvo amṛtasya śikṣāḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कुवित् । मा । गोपां । करसे । जनस्य । कुवित् । राजानं । मघवन् । ऋजेषिन् ।
> कुवित् । मा । ऋषिं । पप्सिवांसं । सुतस्य । कुवित् । मे । वस्वः । अमृतस्य । शिक्षाः॥

> *kuvit | mā | gopāṃ | karase | janasya | kuvit | rājānaṃ | maghavan | ṛjeṣin |*
> *kuvit | mā | ṛṣiṃ | papsivāṃsaṃ | sutasya | kuvit | me | vasvaḥ | amṛtasya | śikṣāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र कुविदपि च मा मां जनस्य गोपां गोप्तारं करसे । कुरु । तथा
> हे मघवन्छनवन्नृजीषिन्नोमवन् हे इंद्र मां राजानं सर्वस्य स्वामिनं कुरु ।
> कुविच्च मा मामृषिमतींद्रियार्थस्य प्रष्टारं कुरु । ऋषिर्दर्शनादिति यास्कः । तथा
> सुतस्याभिषुतस्य सोमस्य पपिवांसं पातारं कुरु । अपि च मे मह्यममृतस्य
> क्षयरहितं वस्वो वसु शिक्षाः । प्रयच्छ ॥ करसे । कृञ् करणे । लेट्यडागमे रूपं।
> कुविद्योगादनिघातः । म ऋषिमित्यत्र संहितायामृत्यक इति प्रकृतिभावो ह्रस्वश्च ।
> पपिवांसं । पा पान इत्यस्य क्वसौ वस्वेकाजाद्घसामितीडागमः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । शिक्षाः ।
> शिक्षतिर्दानकर्मा । आस्माल्लेट्प्याडमे रूपं । कुविद्योगादनिघातः । आगमा अनुदात्ता
> इत्याटोऽनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra kuvidapi ca mā māṃ janasya gopāṃ goptāraṃ karase | kuru | tathā*
> *he maghavanchanavannṛjīṣinnomavan he iṃdra māṃ rājānaṃ sarvasya*

> *svāminaṃ kuru |*
> *kuvicca mā māmṛṣimatīṃdriyārthasya praṣṭāraṃ kuru | ṛṣirdaśanāditi yāskaḥ | tathā*
> *sutasyābhiṣutasya somasya papivāṃsaṃ pātāraṃ kuru | api ca me mahyamamṛtasya*
> *kṣayarahitaṃ vasvo vasu śikṣāḥ | prayaccha ‖ karase | kṛñ karaṇe | leṭyaḍāgame rūpaṃ |*
> *kuvidyogādanighātaḥ | ma ṛṣimityatra saṃhitāyāmṛtyaka iti prakṛtibhāvo hrasvaśca |*
> *papivāṃsaṃ | pā pāna ityasya kvasau vasvekājādbhasāmitīḍāgamaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | śikṣāḥ |*
> *śikṣatirdānakarmā | āsmālleṭpyāḍame rūpaṃ | kuvidyogādanighātaḥ | āgamā anudāttā ityāṭo 'nudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, make me, many times (कुवित् (*kuvit*)), the protector (गोपां (*gopāṃ*)) of the people. O wealthy (मघवन् (*maghavan*)), Soma-possessing Indra, make me king, the lord of all. Make me also a ऋषिं (*ṛṣiṃ*), a questioner of supersensuous matters; "a seer from seeing", says Yāska. Make me also a drinker (पपिवांसं (*papivāṃsaṃ*)) of the pressed Soma. And give me imperishable wealth (अमृतस्य (*amṛtasya*) वस्वः (*vasvaḥ*)). शिक्षाः (*śikṣāḥ*) means 'give'; the root शिक्षति (*śikṣati*) has the sense of giving."[?27]

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) कुवित् (*kuvit*)—many times
- मा (*mā*)—me
- जनस्य (*janasya*)—for the people
- गोपां (*gopāṃ*)—as protector
- करसे (*karase*)—make
- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—wealthy
- ऋजीषिन् (*ṛjīṣin*)—Soma-possessing Indra
- मा (*mā*)—me
- कुवित् (*kuvit*)—likewise
- राजानं (*rājānaṃ*)—make a lord
- कुवित् (*kuvit*)—otherwise

- ऋषिं (*ṛṣiṃ*)—make one capable of seeing supersensuous matters
- सुतस्य (*sutasya*)—of the pressed Soma juice
- पपिवांसं (*papivāṃsaṃ*)—make a drinker
- मे (*me*)—to me
- अमृतस्य (*amṛtasya*)—imperishable
- वस्वः (*vasvaḥ*)—wealth
- शिक्षाः (*śikṣāḥ*)—give

Gist

O Indra, make me the protector of the people. O Indra, possessor of wealth and of Soma, make me a lord. Otherwise, make me one able to see the supersensuous meaning. Make me qualified to drink the Soma juice. Give me imperishable wealth.

English translation

Possessor of wealth, accept of the spiritless Soma juice; make me the protector, or rather a monarch of men; make me verily a holy sage, a drinker of the libation; make me verily the possessor of imperishable wealth.

Special Topics

Kuvit: this word is read among the "many names" of the Nirukta (Ni. 3-1). In the Ṛk Saṃhitā also, in places such as कुवित्स देवीः सनयो नवो वा (*kuvitsa devīḥ sanayo navo vā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-51-4), it is used in the sense "many times, in many ways". In the present Ṛk the word is employed in three senses: first in the established sense कुवित्-अपि च (*kuvit-api ca*); second in a conjunctive sense; the third time in the contrary sense "or".

Ṛṣi: the word ṛṣi is explained here as a knower of reality (tattvajña) who has the capacity to see supersensuous meanings. That the word can bear this meaning was shown earlier in the Special Topics of Ṛk 1-179-6 (Ṛ. Saṃ.). In general the word ṛṣi is used in the Ṛk Saṃhitā in the sense of a poet (kavi) who sees beyond the ordinary:

अग्निः पूर्वभिर्यषिभिरीड्यः (*agniḥ pūrvabhiryaṣibhirīḍyaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-1-2);

ये च पूर्व ऋषयो ये च नूत्नाः (*ye ca pūrva ṛṣayo ye ca nūtnāḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-22-9);

तमेव ऋषिं तमु ब्रह्माणमाहुः (*tameva ṛṣiṃ tamu brahmāṇamāhuḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-107 6).

In such contexts the meaning "poet" is well established, and in contexts such as अग्निं मनुष्या ऋषयः समीधिरे (*agniṃ manuṣyā ṛṣayaḥ samīdhire*) (10-150-4) the meaning "praiser" is well established. The meaning "hotṛ" also becomes possible in some places.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ त्वा॑ बृ॒हन्तो॒ हर॑यो युजा॒ना अ॒र्वागि॑न्द्र सध॒मा
दो॑ वहन्तु ।
प्र ये द्वि॒ता दि॒व ऋ॒ञ्जन्त्याता॒ः सुसं॑म्मृष्टासो वृष॒भ
स्यं॑ मू॒राः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ā tvā bṛhanto harayo yujānā arvāgindra sadhamādo vahantu |*
> *pra ye dvitā diva ṛñjantyātāḥ susammṛṣṭāso vṛṣabhasya mūrāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । त्वा । बृहंतः । हरयः । युजानाः । अर्वाक् । इंद्र । सध्वमादः । वहंतु ।
> प्र । ये । द्विता । दिवः । यंजंति । आताः । सुसंमृष्टासः । वृषभस्य । मूराः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ā | tvā | bṛhaṃtaḥ | harayaḥ | yujānāḥ | arvāk | iṃdra | sadhvamādaḥ | vahaṃtu |*
> *pra | ye | dvitā | divaḥ | yaṃjaṃti | ātāḥ | susaṃmṛṣṭāsaḥ | vṛṣabhasya | mūrāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वा त्वां बृहंतो महांतो युजाना रथे युज्यमाना
> हरयोऽश्वाः सधमादः सह मादयंतः संतोऽर्वाक् अस्मदभिमुखमा वहंतु ।
> वृषभस्य कामानां वर्षितुरिंद्रस्य मूराः शत्रोणां मारकाः सुसंमृष्टास इंद्रस्य
> हस्ताभ्यां पृष्ठभागे सुष्टु संस्पृष्टा दिवो नभसः सकाशादागच्छंतो येऽश्वा

> आताः । अभिमुख्यन गम्यंते प्राणिभिस्तत्तत्कार्यं प्रतीत्याता दिशः । सर्वा दिशो
> द्विता द्वैधं यथा भवति तथा प्र ऋंजंति । प्रकर्षण साधयंति ॥ युजानाः ।
> युजिर् योगे युजिबुधिदृशः किच्च । उ. २.९०. । इत्यानच् । चित्वादंतोदात्तः ।
> सधमादः । मदी हर्ष इत्यस्माण्यंतात् क्विप् । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । द्विता । द्विशब्दात्संख्याया
> विधार्थे धेति धाप्रत्ययः । धकारस्य तकारश्छांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ।
> दिवः । ऊडिदमिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । आताः । आत सातत्यगमन इत्यस्मात्कर्मणि घञ् ।
> व्यत्ययेनाद्युदात्तः ।

> *he iṃdra tvā tvāṃ bṛhaṃto mahāṃto yujānā rathe yujyamānā*
> *harayo 'śvāḥ sadhamādaḥ saha mādayaṃtaḥ saṃto 'rvāk*
> *asmadabhimukhamā vahaṃtu |*
> *vṛṣabhasya kāmānāṃ varṣituriṃdrasya mūrāḥ śatroṇāṃ mārakāḥ*
> *susaṃmṛṣṭāsa iṃdrasya*
> *hastābhyāṃ pṛṣṭhabhāge suṣṭu saṃspṛṣṭā divo nabhasaḥ*
> *sakāśādāgacchaṃto ye 'śvā*
> *ātāḥ | abhimukhyana gamyaṃte prāṇibhistattatkāryaṃ pratītyātā diśaḥ*
> *| sarvā diśo*
> *dvitā dvaidhaṃ yathā bhavati tathā pra ṛṃjaṃti | prakarṣaṇa*
> *sādhayaṃti || yujānāḥ |*
> *yujir yoge yujibudhidṛśaḥ kicca | u. 2.90. | ityānac | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ |*
> *sadhamādaḥ | madī harṣa ityasmāṇyaṃtāt kvip | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ*
> *| dvitā | dviśabdātsaṃkhyāyā vidhārthe dheti dhāpratyayaḥ |*
> *dhakārasya takāraścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *divaḥ | ūḍidamiti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | ātāḥ | āta sātatyagamana*
> *ityasmātkarmaṇi ghañ |*
> *vyatyayenādyudāttaḥ |*

Summary

O Indra, may the great (बृहंतः (*bṛhaṃtaḥ*)) horses, yoked to the chariot, delighting together (सधमादः (*sadhamādaḥ*)), bring you hither, toward us. Those horses are the slayers (मूराः (*mūrāḥ*)) of the enemies of Indra, the "bull", the showerer of desires. They are well rubbed (सुसंमृष्टासः (*susaṃmṛṣṭāsaḥ*)) on the back by Indra's two hands, and they come from heaven, from the sky. They are ātāḥ: the directions are called ātāḥ because creatures go toward them for their various tasks. These horses accomplish (प्र ऋंजंति (*pra ṛṃjaṃti*): they bring to completion eminently) all the directions in a twofold manner (द्विता (*dvitā*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- बृहंतः (*bṛhaṃtaḥ*)—of great form
- युजानाः (*yujānāḥ*)—yoked to the chariot
- हरयः (*harayaḥ*)—horses
- सधमादः (*sadhamādaḥ*)—rejoicing together
- अर्वाक् (*arvāk*)—toward us
- आ वहंतु (*ā vahaṃtu*)—let them bring
- वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*)—of Indra, the showerer of desires
- मूराः (*mūrāḥ*)—destroyers (of enemies)
- सुसंमृष्टासः (*susaṃmṛṣṭāsaḥ*)—(lovingly) patted on the back
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from the atmosphere
- ये (*ye*)—which, those very horses
- आताः (*ātāḥ*)—in all directions
- द्विता (*dvitā*)—doubled
- प्र ऋंजंति (*pra ṛṃjaṃti*)—(exceedingly) shine

Gist

O Indra, may the great horses, yoked to the chariot, rejoicing together, bring you toward us. Those same horses of Indra, the showerer of desires, destroyers of enemies, patted on the back, shine doubled in all the directions.

English translation

May your mighty horses, Indra, harnessed (in your car), and alike exhilarated (by the beverage) bring you to our presence, for they are the destroyers (of the foes) of the showerer (of benefits), and kindly rubbed by his hand they traverse, going quickly, the regions of the sky, making them as it were twofold.

Special Topics

Mūrāḥ: for the word mūra the meaning "foolish" (mūḍha), i.e. ignorant, is generally well known; mūra is popularly an ignorant person and amūra a knowing one. In the present Ṛk, however, Sāyaṇa explains the word as a destroying power. The scholar Monier Wiliam, explaining this word, cites this very Ṛk and in his dictionary gives the meaning "Rushing, impetuous"; he also records Sāyaṇa's opinion "destroyer" (māraka). Besides, it also means "firm, secure, well established". The word is also used in the sense of "root, base" (A. Ve. 1-28-3).[?28]

Ātāḥ: since it is the means by which birds and others move here and there, ātā is a synonym for the side of a direction. In many places it also means the door of a shutter.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ पिब॒ वृष॑धूतस्य॒ वृष्ण॒ आ यं ते॑ श्ये॒न उ॑श॒ते ज॒भार॑ ।
यस्य॒ मदे॑ च्या॒वय॑सि॒ प्र कृ॒ष्टीर्यस्य॒ मदे॒ अप॑ गो॒त्रा व॒वर्थ॑ ॥ ७ ॥

> *indra piba vṛṣadhūtasya vṛṣṇa ā yaṃ te śyena uśate jabhāra |*
> *yasya made cyāvayasi pra kṛṣṭīryasya made apa gotrā vavartha ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । पिब । वृषधूतस्य । वृष्णः ! आ । यं । ते । श्येनः । उशते । जभार ।
> यस्य । मदे । च्यवयसि । प्र । कृष्टीः । यस्य । मदे । अप । गोत्रा । ववर्थ ॥ ७ ॥

> *iṃdra | piba | vṛṣadhūtasya | vṛṣṇaḥ ! ā | yaṃ | te | śyenaḥ | uśate | jabhāra |*
> *yasya | made | cyavayasi | pra | kṛṣṭīḥ | yasya | made | apa | gotrā | vavartha ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वृषधूतस्य ग्रावभिरभिषुतं वृष्णोऽभिमतफलसेचकं सोमं
> पिब । श्येनः शंसनीयगतिश्चंदोरूपः सुपर्ण उशते सोमं कामयमानाय

> *he iṃdra vṛṣadhūtasya grāvabhirabhiṣutaṃ vṛṣṇo 'bhimataphalasecakaṃ somaṃ*
> *piba | śyenaḥ śaṃsanīyagatiścaṃdorūpaḥ suparṇa uśate somaṃ kāmayamānāya*

> ते तुभ्यं यं सोममा जभार । आजहार । यस्य सोमस्य मदे हर्ष संजाते
> सति कृष्टीः । आकर्षंति वशीकुर्वंति कर्मणा सर्वानिति कृस्टयो मनुष्याः । तान्
> सपत्नभूतान्मनुष्यान् प्र च्यावयसि । प्रकर्षण पातयसि । यस्य सोमस्य मदे
> संजाते सति गोत्रा । गामुदकं रश्मिभिरावृतं वर्षास्वतुषु त्रायंते पालयंतीति
> गोत्रा मुघाः । तानह ववर्थ । अपवृणेषि ॥ वृषधूतस्य । धूञ् कंपन इत्यस्य
> निष्ठायां यस्य विभाषेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदस्वरः । शैनः ।
> श्येज् गतौ । श्यास्ताहृञ्विभ्य इनच् । उ २.४६. । इतीनच् प्रत्ययः । श्यायत इति
> शैनः । चित्तादंतोदात्तः । जभार । हरतेर्लिटि णलि रूपं । हृग्रहोर्भश्चंदसीति
> भकारः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । लित्स्वरः । मदे । मदी हर्षे । मदोऽनुपसर्ग
> इत्यप्रत्ययः । तस्य पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । गोत्रा । त्रैज् पालन इत्यस्यातोऽनुपसर्गे क
> इति कः । सुपो डादेशः । एकादेशस्वरः । ववर्थ । वृञ् वरण इत्यस्य
> लिट थल्यतो भारद्वाजस्येतीट् प्रतिषेधः । गुणः लित्स्वरः ॥

> *te tubhyaṃ yaṃ somamā jabhāra | ājahāra | yasya somasya made harṣa saṃjāte*
> *sati kṛṣṭīḥ | ākarṣaṃti vaśīkurvaṃti karmaṇā sarvāniti kṛsṭayo manuṣyāḥ | tān*
> *sapatnabhūtānmanuṣyān pra cyāvayasi | prakarṣaṇa pātayasi | yasya somasya made*
> *saṃjāte sati gotrā | gāmudakaṃ raśmibhirāvṛtaṃ varṣāsvatuṣu trāyaṃte pālayaṃtīti*
> *gotrā mughāḥ | tānaha vavartha | apavṛṇeṣi ‖ vṛṣadhūtasya | dhūñ kaṃpana ityasya*
> *niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya vibhāṣetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvapadasvaraḥ | śainaḥ |*
> *śyej gatau | śyāstāhṛñvibhya inac | u 2.46. | itīnac pratyayaḥ | śyāyata iti*
> *śainaḥ | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | jabhāra | haraterliṭi ṇali rūpaṃ |*

> *hṛgrahorbhaścaṃdasīti*
> *bhakāraḥ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | litsvaraḥ | made | madī harṣe |*
> *mado 'nupasarga*
> *ityapratyayaḥ | tasya pitvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | gotrā | traij*
> *pālana ityasyāto 'nupasarge ka iti kaḥ | supo ḍādeśaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ |*
> *vavartha | vṛñ varaṇa ityasya*
> *liṭa thalyato bhāradvājasyetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | guṇaḥ litsvaraḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, drink the Soma that is pressed with the stones (ग्रावभिरभिषुतं (*grāvabhirabhiṣutaṃ*)) and is the sprinkler (वृष्णः (*vṛṣṇaḥ*)) of the desired fruit. The Śyena, the hawk of praiseworthy flight, who has the form of a metre, brought (जभार (*jabhāra*): आजहार (*ājahāra*)) to you, who desire Soma, that Soma.

When joy is born from that Soma, you make fall, you cast down eminently, the kṛṣṭayaḥ, human beings who are your rivals (kṛṣṭayaḥ are people who draw all, bring all under control, by their action). When joy is born from that Soma, you uncover (अप ववर्थ (*apa vavartha*): अपवृणेषि (*apavṛṇeṣi*)) the gotrās, the clouds, which in the rainy seasons protect (त्रायंते पालयंतीति (*trāyaṃte pālayaṃtīti*)) the water enveloped in rays (go means water).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- यं (*yaṃ*)—which Soma
- श्येनः (*śyenaḥ*)—the Śyena bird in the form of a metre
- उशते (*uśate*)—to you who desired it
- ते (*te*)—for you
- आ जभार (*ā jabhāra*)—brought (and)
- यस्य (*yasya*)—by drinking which Soma juice
- मदे (*made*)—becoming exhilarated
- कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*)—men (who are enemies)
- प्रच्यावयसि (*pracyāvayasi*)—you beat down and drive away (and)
- यस्य (*yasya*)—by drinking which Soma juice
- मदे (*made*)—becoming exhilarated

- गोत्रा (*gotrā*)—the clouds
- अप ववर्थ (*apa vavartha*)—you split open; such
- वृषधूतस्य (*vṛṣadhūtasya*)—pressed by the pressing stones
- वृष्णः (*vṛṣṇaḥ*)—the Soma that grants desires
- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, drink that pressed Soma juice, the granter of desires, which the Śyena bird in the form of a metre brought for you who desired it; by drinking which, rejoicing, you beat down the enemies; and by drinking which Soma, exhilarated, you split open the clouds for the sake of rain.

English translation

Drink, Indra, of the bountiful (libation) expressed by the beneficent (stones); that which the falcon has borne to you desiring it, in whose exhi- laration you cast down (opposing) men, in whose exhilaration you have set open the clouds.

Special Topics

Śyena: the occasion on which the Śyena bird, of the nature of the Gāyatrī, brought the Soma was told earlier, and it will be told later when the greatness of the Gāyatrī is described.

Kṛṣṭīḥ: the special meanings of the words kṛṣṭi and carṣaṇi were explained earlier. The uses of the words pañcakṛṣṭayaḥ and pañcajanāḥ, which signify identity, were also explained.

Gotrā: the word gotra generally means a cowshed that protects cows; this is well known, and the same meaning is indicated in the Nirukta (Ni. 1-2). In the present Ṛk gotra is explained as "cloud". Since the word go is a synonym of water, and since the cloud holds back and protects the water, gotra also means "cloud". The special meaning of this word will be explained when Indra's valour is described with the word गोत्रभित् (*gotrabhit*).

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शु॒नं हु॑वेम म॒घवा॑न॒मिन्द्र॑म॒स्मिन्भरे॒ नृत॑मं॒ वाज॑सातौ
।
शृ॒ण्वन्त॑मु॒ग्रमू॒तये॑ स॒मत्सु॒ घ्नन्तं᳚ वृ॒त्राणि॑ सं॒जितं॒ धना॑नाम् ॥ ८ ॥

> *śunaṃ huvema maghavānamindramasminbhare nṛtamaṃ vājasātau |*
> *śṛṇvantamugramūtaye samatsu ghnantaṃ vṛtrāṇi saṃjitaṃ dhanānām ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुनं । हुवेम । मघवानं । इंद्रं । अस्मिन् । भरे । नृतमं । वाजसात् ।
> शृण्वंतं । उग्रं । ऊतये । समत्सु । घ्नंतं । वृत्राणि । संजितं । धनानां ॥

> *śunaṃ | huvema | maghavānaṃ | iṃdraṃ | asmin | bhare | nṛtamaṃ | vājasāt |*
> *śṛṇvaṃtaṃ | ugraṃ | ūtaye | samatsu | ghnaṃtaṃ | vṛtrāṇi | saṃjitaṃ | dhanānāṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वाजसात् । वाजस्यान्नस्य सातिर्लाभो यस्मिन् सोऽयं वाजसातिः।
> अस्मिन्भरे । बिभ्रति जयलक्ष्मीमनेन योद्धार इति भरः संग्रामः । तस्मिन् संग्रामे
> शुनं शूनमुत्साहेन प्रवृद्धं । यद्वा शुनमिति सुखनाम । सुखकरं मघवानं धनवंतं आत एवेंद्रं
> निरतिशयैश्वर्यसंपन्नं नृतमं सर्वस्य जगतोऽतिशयेन
> नेतारं त्वां हुवेम । कुशिका वयं यज्ञार्थमाह्वयेम । तथा तृण्यंतमस्माभिः
> क्रियमाणां स्तुतिं शृण्यंतमुग्रं शत्रूणां भयंकरं समत्तु संग्रामेषु वृत्राणि

> *he iṃdra vājasāt | vājasyānnasya sātirlābho yasmin so 'yaṃ vājasātiḥ|*
> *asminbhare | bibhrati jayalakṣmīmanena yoddhāra iti bharaḥ saṃgrāmaḥ | tasmin saṃgrāme*
> *śunaṃ śūnamutsāhena pravṛddhaṃ | yadvā śunamiti sukhanāma |*
> *sukhakaraṃ maghavānaṃ dhanavaṃtaṃ āta eveṃdraṃ*

> *niratiśayaiśvaryasaṃpannaṃ nṛtamaṃ sarvasya jagato 'tiśayena netāraṃ tvāṃ huvema | kuśikā vayaṃ yajñārthamāhvayema | tathā tṛṇyaṃtamasmābhiḥ*
> *kriyamāṇāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇyaṃtamugraṃ śatrūṇāṃ bhayaṃkaraṃ samattu saṃgrāmeṣu vṛtrāṇi*

> वृत्रोपलक्षितानि सर्वाणि रक्षांसि घ्नंतं हिंसंतं धनानां शत्रुसंबंधिनां संजितं
> सम्यग्नेतारं त्वामूतये रक्षणाय वयमाह्वयेम ॥ शुनं । टुओश्वि गतिवृद्ध्योरित्यस्य निष्ठायां यस्य विभाषेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । दीर्घाभावश्चांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हुवेम । ह्वयतेर्बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणे कृते
> शपो लुकि कृते च लिजि रूपं । निघातः । भरे । बृञ् भरणे । घः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः । वाजसात् । षणु दाने । भावे क्तिन् । जनसनेत्यादिनानुनासिकस्यात्वं ।
> बहुप्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । समत्तु । अद भक्षणे । संपूर्वात् क्विप् । संभक्षयंति
> योद्धाणामायूंशीति समदः संग्रामाः ! कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । घ्नंतं । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य शतरि गमहनेत्यादिनोपधालोपः । हो हंतेरिति घत्वं । संजितं ।
> जि जये । क्विप् !'

> *vṛtropalakṣitāni sarvāṇi rakṣāṃsi ghnaṃtaṃ hiṃsaṃtaṃ dhanānāṃ śatrusaṃbaṃdhināṃ saṃjitaṃ*
> *samyagnetāraṃ tvāmūtaye rakṣaṇāya vayamāhvayema ‖ śunaṃ | ṭuości gativṛddhyorityasya niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya vibhāṣetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | huvema | hvayaterbahulaṃ chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe kṛte*
> *śapo luki kṛte ca liji rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | bhare | bṛñ bharaṇe | ghaḥ | vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ | vājasāt | ṣaṇu dāne | bhāve ktin | janasanetyādinānunāsikasyātvaṃ |*
> *bahuprīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | samattu | ada bhakṣaṇe | saṃpūrvāt kvip | saṃbhakṣayaṃti*
> *yoddhāṇāmāyūṃśīti samadaḥ saṃgrāmāḥ ! kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | ghnaṃtaṃ | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya śatari gamahanetyādinopadhālopaḥ | ho haṃteriti ghatvaṃ | saṃjitaṃ |*
> *ji jaye | kvip ! '*

Summary

O Indra, vājasāt: the one in whom there is the gain (सातिः (*sātiḥ*)) of food (वाज (*vāja*)). Bhara is battle, since in it warriors bear (बिभ्रति (*bibhrati*)) the goddess of victory. In this battle we call you, who are śuna, swollen, grown through enthusiasm; or else śuna is a name for happiness, so "making happiness"; who are wealthy (मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)), and therefore Indra endowed with unsurpassed lordship, the supreme leader (नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)) of the whole world. We Kuśikas call you for the sacrifice. We call you who hear the praise made by us, fierce (उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)), a terror to enemies, in the battles (समत्सु (*samatsu*))...

...who destroy (घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)) all the Rākṣasas, who are called by the name Vṛtra; who is the good leader and conqueror (संजितं (*saṃjitaṃ*)) of the wealth belonging to the enemies. We call you for protection (ऊतये (*ūtaye*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)—proceeding for the sake of food
- भरे (*bhare*)—in the battle
- शुनं (*śunaṃ*)—who grow through enthusiasm, or who produce happiness
- मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)—wealthy
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—endowed with unsurpassed lordship
- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—the leader; you
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—we invoke and call (likewise)
- शृण्वंतं (*śṛṇvaṃtaṃ*)—who listen (to our praises)
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—fearsome to enemies
- समत्तु (*samattu*)—in battles
- वृत्राणि (*vṛtrāṇi*)—the Asuras beginning with Vṛtra
- घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)—who injure and destroy
- धनानां (*dhanānāṃ*)—the wealth (of enemies)
- संचितं (*saṃcitaṃ*)—who gather and give (to us); you
- ऊतये (*ūtaye*)—for protection
- हवेम (*havema*)—(we invoke and call)

Gist

O Indra, in the battle waged for the sake of food, you who produce happiness, are wealthy, are endowed with unsurpassed lordship, are the leader, listen to our praises, are fearsome to enemies, injure and destroy Vṛtra and the other Asuras in battles, and gather the wealth of the enemies and give it to us—you we invoke and call for protection.

English translation

We invoke for our protection the opulent Indra, distinguished in this combat, the leader in the food-bestowing (strife), hearing (our praises), terri-ble in battles, the destroyer of foes, the conqueror of wealth.

Special Topics

The special topics of this Ṛk have already been explained earlier.

Sūkta 44 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अयं ते अस्त्विति पंचर्चं षष्ठं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं बार्हतमैंद्रं ।
> अत्रानुक्रमणिका । आयं ते पंच बार्हतं त्विति ॥ महाव्रते बार्हत्यां तृचाशीताविदं सूक्तं । ऐ. आ ५२ ॥ षोडशिशस्त्रेयं ते अस्तु हर्यत इत्याद्यस्तृचो विनियुक्तः ! सूत्रितं च । आयं ते अस्तु हर्यत इत्यौष्टिहबार्हतौ तृचौ । आ. ६.२ ।
> इति !!
> अनुवादवु — आयं ते अस्तु ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि आरनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि ऐदु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु, इंद्रनु देवतॆयु, बृहती छंदस्सु– अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—आयं ते पंच बार्हतं तु ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. महाव्रत दल्लि बृहती छंदस्सिन तृच (मूरु ऋक्कु) क्कागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु ऐतरेयारण्य कदल्लियू (ऐ. आ. ५–२) षोडशियॆंब यागदल्लि शस्त्रमंत्रपठनकालदल्लि आयं ते अस्तु हर्यतः ऎंब ई सूक्तद मॊदलनॆय मूरु ऋक्कुगळ विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु अश्वलायनश्रौत सूत्रद—आयं ते अस्तु हर्यत इत्यौष्ठिहबार्हत् तृचौ ऎंब सूत्रदिंदलू विवृत वागिरुवुदु (आ. ६–२).
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—४४
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—४४ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—८ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—५ ॥
> ॥ ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ॥
> ॥ देवता—इंद्रः ॥
> ॥ छंदः—बृहती ॥

> *ayaṃ te astviti paṃcarcaṃ ṣaṣṭhaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ bārhatamaiṃdraṃ |*
> *atrānukramaṇikā | āyaṃ te paṃca bārhataṃ tviti ‖ mahāvrate bārhatyāṃ tṛcāśītāvidaṃ sūktaṃ | ai. ā 52 ‖ ṣoḍaśiśastreyaṃ te astu haryata ityādyastṛco viniyuktaḥ ! sūtritaṃ ca | āyaṃ te astu haryata ityauṣṭihabārhatau tṛcau | ā. 6.2 |*
> *iti !!*
> *anuvādavu — āyaṃ te astu èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli āranèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli aidu ṛkkugaḻiruvavu. ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu, iṃdranu*

> *devatèyu, bṛhatī*
> *chaṃdassu- anukramaṇikèyalli—āyaṃ te paṃca bārhataṃ tu èṃdu*
> *heḷiruvudu. mahāvrata*
> *dalli bṛhatī chaṃdassina tṛca (mūru ṛkku) kkāgi ī sūktada*
> *viniyogaviruvudèṃdu aitareyāraṇya*
> *kadalliyū (ai. ā. 5-2) ṣoḍaśiyèṃba yāgadalli*
> *śastramaṃtrapaṭhanakāladalli āyaṃ te astu*
> *haryataḥ èṃba ī sūktada mòdalanèya mūru ṛkkugaḷa*
> *viniyogaviruvudèṃdu aśvalāyanaśrauta*
> *sūtrada—āyaṃ te astu haryata ityauṣṭhihabārhat tṛcau èṃba*
> *sūtradiṃdalū vivṛta*
> *vāgiruvudu (ā. 6-2).*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—44*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—44 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—8 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—5 ‖*
> *‖ ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ ‖*
> *‖ devatā—iṃdraḥ ‖*
> *‖ chaṃdaḥ—bṛhatī ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta अयं ते अस्तु (*ayaṃ te astu*), of five Ṛks, is the sixth sūkta; its seer is Viśvāmitra, it is Bārhata in metre and addressed to Indra. On it the Anukramaṇikā says आयं ते पंच बार्हतं त्विति (*āyaṃ te paṃca bārhataṃ tviti*). In the Mahāvrata this sūkta is used for the Bṛhatī tṛca: महाव्रते बार्हत्यां तृचाशीताविदं सूक्तं (*mahāvrate bārhatyāṃ tṛcāśītāvidaṃ sūktaṃ*) (Ai. Ā. 52). In the Ṣoḍaśin śastra the first tṛca of it, beginning अयं ते अस्तु हर्यतः (*ayaṃ te astu haryataḥ*), is applied; and it is given in the sūtra: आयं ते अस्तु हर्यत इत्यौष्टिहबार्हतौ तृचौ (*āyaṃ te astu haryata ityauṣṭihabārhatau tṛcau*) (Ā. 6-2).

The Anuvāda adds the particulars: Maṇḍala 3, Anuvāka 4, Sūkta 44; Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 3, Varga 8; number of Ṛks in the sūkta 5; seer Viśvāmitra; deity Indra; metre Bṛhatī. It gives the Aitareya Āraṇyaka reference as Ai. Ā. 5-2 and the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra reference as 6-2.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं ते॑ अस्तु हर्य॒तः सोम॒ आ हरि॑भिः सु॒तः ।
जु॒षा॒ण इ॑न्द्र॒ हरि॑भिर्न॒ आ ग॒ह्या ति॑ष्ठ॒ हरि॑तं॒ र
थ॑म् ॥ १ ॥

> *ayaṃ te astu haryataḥ soma ā haribhiḥ sutaḥ |*
> *juṣāṇa indra haribhirna ā gahyā tiṣṭha haritaṃ ratham ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । ते । अस्तु । हर्यतः । सोमः । आ । हरिभिः । सुतः ।
> जुषाणः । इंद्र । हरिभिः । नः । आ । गहि । आ । तिष्ठ । हरितं । रथं ॥ १ ॥

> *ayaṃ | te | astu | haryataḥ | somaḥ | ā | haribhiḥ | sutaḥ |*
> *juṣāṇaḥ | iṃdra | haribhiḥ | naḥ | ā | gahi | ā | tiṣṭha | haritaṃ |*
> *rathaṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र हरिभिः । हरंति सोमरसानेभिरिति हरयो ग्रावाणः । तैरा सुतः
> सर्वतोऽभिषुतो हर्यतः कमनीयो जषाणः प्रीतिविषयोऽयं सोमस्ते
> तुभ्यमस्तु । त्वं हरिभिरश्वैर्युक्तं हरितं हरिद्वर्णं रथमा तिष्ठ । अधितिष्ठ्य । ततो
> नोऽस्मानभिलक्ष्या गहि । आगच्छ ॥ हर्यतः । हर्य गतिकांतोरित्यस्मादृमृदृशीत्यादिनातच्
> प्रत्ययः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । हरितं । हृञ् हरणे । दृश्याभ्यामितन् ।
> उ. ३–९३ । इतीतन्न प्रत्ययः ! नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । रथं । रमु क्रीडायां । हनिकुषिनीत्यादिना
> क्फन्न प्रत्ययः । कित्वादनुनासिकलोपः । नित्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra haribhiḥ | haraṃti somarasānebhiriti harayo grāvāṇaḥ | tairā sutaḥ*
> *sarvato 'bhiṣuto haryataḥ kamanīyo jaṣāṇaḥ prītiviṣayo 'yaṃ somaste*
> *tubhyamastu | tvaṃ haribhiraśvairyuktaṃ haritaṃ haridvarṇaṃ rathamā tiṣṭha | adhitiṣya | tato*
> *no 'smānabhilakṣyā gahi | āgaccha ‖ haryataḥ | harya gatikāṃtorityasmādṛmṛdṛśītyādinātac pratyayaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ |*
> *haritaṃ | hṛñ haraṇe | dṛśyābhyāmitan |*

> *u. 3-93 | itītanna pratyayaḥ ! nitvādādyudāttaḥ | rathaṃ | ramu krīḍāyāṃ | hanikuṣinītyādinā kphanna pratyayaḥ | kitvādanunāsikalopaḥ | nitvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, the harayaḥ are the pressing-stones, so called because they carry off (हरंति (*haraṃti*)) the Soma juice. This Soma, pressed all round by them, desirable and an object of delight, is for you. Mount the green-hued chariot yoked with tawny horses (हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)), and then come towards us.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—by the pressing-stones
- आ सुतः (*ā sutaḥ*)—fully pressed
- हर्यतः (*haryataḥ*)—attractive
- जुषाणः (*juṣāṇaḥ*)—dear, an object of delight
- आयं सोमः (*āyaṃ somaḥ*)—this Soma juice
- ते (*te*)—directed to you
- अस्तु (*astu*)—is ready
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—joined with horses
- हरितं (*haritaṃ*)—of green colour
- रथं (*rathaṃ*)—in the chariot
- आ तिष्ठ (*ā tiṣṭha*)—mount and sit
- नः (*naḥ*)—towards us
- आ गहि (*ā gahi*)—be gracious to come

Gist

O Indra, this Soma juice, fully pressed by the pressing-stones, attractive and dear, is ready for you. Mount and sit in the green-coloured chariot yoked with horses, and be gracious to come towards us.

English translation

May this desirable and gratifying Soma expressed by the stones, be, Indra, for you : ascend the verdant chariot, and with your tawny (steeds) come to us.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ह॒र्यन्नु॒षसं॑मर्चय॒ः सूर्यं॑ ह॒र्यन्नं॑रोचयः ।
वि॒द्वाँश्चिं॑कि॒त्वान्हं॑र्यश्व वर्धस॒ इन्द्र॒ विश्वा॑ अ॒भि श्रि
यं॑ः ॥ २ ॥

> *haryannuṣasamarcayaḥ sūryaṃ haryannarocayaḥ |*
> *vidvā~ścikitvānharyaśva vardhasa indra viśvā abhi śriyaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> हर्यन् । उषसं । अर्चयः । सूर्यं । हर्यन् । आरोचयः ।
> विद्वान् । चिकित्वान् । हरिअश्व । वर्धसे । इंद्र । विश्वाः । अभि । श्रियः ॥ २ ॥

> *haryan | uṣasaṃ | arcayaḥ | sūryaṃ | haryan | ārocayaḥ |*
> *vidvān | cikitvān | hariaśva | vardhase | iṃdra | viśvāḥ | abhi | śriyaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र हर्यन् सोमं कामयमानस्त्वमुषसमुषःकालमर्चयः ।
> पूजयसि । तथा हर्यन्नुदिते सूर्ये सोमं कामयमानस्त्वं सूर्यमरोचयः । दीपयसि । हे हर्यश्वेंद्र विद्यानेतत्सर्वं जानानश्चि कित्वानस्मदभिलषितफलविषयज्ञानवांस्तं विश्वाः सर्वाः श्रियो नः संपदोऽभि वर्धसे । अभिमतफलप्रदानेनाभितो वर्धयसि ॥ चिकित्वान् । कित ज्ञान इत्यस्य क्वसौ रूपं । प्रत्ययस्वरः ।
> वर्धसे । वृधु वर्धन इत्य स्यांतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य लटि रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *he iṃdra haryan somaṃ kāmayamānastvamuṣasamuṣaḥkālamarcayaḥ | pūjayasi | tathā haryannudite sūryè somaṃ kāmayamānastvaṃ sūryamarocayaḥ | dīpayasi | he haryaśveṃdra vidyānetatsarvaṃ jānānaści kitvānasmadabhilaṣitaphalaviṣayajñānavāṃstaṃ viśvāḥ*

> *sarvāḥ śriyo naḥ saṃpado 'bhi vardhase |*
> *abhimataphalapradānenābhito vardhayasi ‖ cikitvān | kita jñāna ityasya kvasau rūpaṃ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *vardhase | vṛdhu vardhana itya syāṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya laṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, desiring (हर्यन् (*haryan*)) Soma, you honour the Dawn, the time of dawn. Likewise, desiring Soma when the sun has risen, you make the sun shine. O Indra, lord of tawny horses, knowing all this and aware of the fruit we desire, you increase all our prosperity on every side by granting the desired fruit.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra, you
- हर्यन् (*haryan*)—desiring the drinking of Soma
- उषसं (*uṣasaṃ*)—the time of dawn
- अर्चयः (*arcayaḥ*)—you honour
- हर्यन् (*haryan*)—desiring the Soma (offered after sunrise)
- सूरं (*sūraṃ*)—the sun
- अरोचयः (*arocayaḥ*)—you make shine
- हरश्व (*haraśva*)—O Indra, possessing horses named Hari
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—knowing everything
- चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*)—knowing our desired ends
- विश्वाः श्रियः (*viśvāḥ śriyaḥ*)—all riches
- अभि वर्धसे (*abhi vardhase*)—you cause to increase among us

Gist

O Indra, desiring the drinking of the Soma offered before sunrise, you honour the time of dawn. Then, desiring the Soma offered afterwards, you make the sun shine. O Indra, possessor of the horses named Hari, being all-knowing and knowing our desired ends, you cause all riches to increase among us.

English translation

Desiring (the Soma), you honour the dawn ; desiring the Soma, you have lighted up the sun ; knowing and discriminating (all our wishes), lord of the tawny steeds, you augment upon us all (sorts of) prosperity.

Special Topics

As the words of the Supreme Person say, उत्तीदेयुरिमे लोकाः न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहं (*uttīdeyurime lokāḥ na kuryāṃ karma cedahaṃ*)[?29]—"if I did not perform action, all the worlds would perish"—so, if Indra, the lord of the universe, were not constantly engaged in action useful for the conduct of the world, the ruin of the world would be certain. He is the cause of the appearance of Dawn and of the rising of the sun. As described in स्वराजः, महतः, ते (*svarājaḥ, mahataḥ, te*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-46-1), he alone is lord of the whole universe and holds sovereign rank. Even so, because the performance of sacrifice nourishes the world and is the cause of the growth of prosperity of the whole world, of gods, men and others, it is said that Indra honoured Dawn and the Sun, the primary causes of that sacrifice. The purport of the present Ṛk is that, though himself the lord, he worshipped his own creation, which nourishes the world.

The two epithets विद्वान् (*vidvān*) and चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*) are also noteworthy here. Indra is all-knowing and knows the intention of the sacrificer. Therefore, being the cause of the appearance of Dawn so as to suit the mutual dealings of gods and men, he worshipped that Dawn of great form. In this sūkta, from beginning to end, a spiritual principle lies hidden. The epithet हरस्व (*harasva*) and descriptions such as सूर्र्यं अरोचयः (*sūryaṃ arocayaḥ*) and उषसं अर्चयः (*uṣasaṃ arcayaḥ*) indicate this hidden meaning. Although an explanation of these is quite necessary, there is no room here for a detailed one, because of limits of space. It will be explained later as occasion arises.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

द्यामिन्द्रो॒ हरि॑धायसं पृथि॒वीं हरि॑वर्पसम् ।
अधा॑रयद्ध॒रितो॒र्भूरि॒ भोज॑नं॒ ययो॑र॒न्तर्हरि॒श्चरं॑त् ॥ ३
॥

> *dyāmindro haridhāyasaṃ pṛthivīṃ harivarpasam |*
> *adhārayaddharitorbhūri bhojanaṃ yayorantarhariścarat ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> द्यां । इंद्रः । हरिधायसं । सृथिवीं । हरिवर्पसं ।
> अधारयत् । हरितोः । भूरि । भोजनं । ययोः । अंतः । हरिः । चरत् ॥ ३ ॥

> *dyāṃ | iṃdraḥ | haridhāyasaṃ | sṛthivīṃ | harivarpasaṃ |*
> *adhārayat | haritoḥ | bhūri | bhojanaṃ | yayoḥ | aṃtaḥ | hariḥ | carat*
> *‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोऽयमिंद्रो हरिधायसं । हरितो हरितवर्णा धायसो धारका
> रत्नयो यस्याः सा । तां द्यामधारयत् । तथा हरिवर्पसनोषधीभिर्हरितवर्णां

> *so 'yamiṃdro haridhāyasaṃ | harito haritavarṇā dhāyaso dhārakā*
> *ratnayo yasyāḥ sā | tāṃ dyāmadhārayat | tathā*
> *harivarpasanoṣadhībhirharitavarṇāṃ*

> पृथिवीमधारयत् । हरितोर्हरिद्वर्णयोर्ययोर्द्यावापृथिव्योर्मध्ये स्वकीययोरश्वयोर्भूरि प्रभूतं भोजनं
> । भुज्यत इति भोजनं यवसादि । लभ्यते ।
> ययोश्च व्यावापृथिव्योरः तर्मध्ये हरिरिंद्रश्चरत् । चरति । ते द्यावापृथिव्यानिंद्रोऽधारयदित्यर्थः
> ॥ हरिधायसं । डुधाण् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्माद्वहिहाथाञ्छंदसीत्यसुन् । णुदित्यनुवृत्तेरातो
> युक् । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः ।
> पृथिवीं । प्रथेः शिवन् संप्रसारणं चेति पिवन्त्ययः । षिद्गौरादिभ्यश्चति जीष् ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरेणांतोदात्तः । हरिवर्पसं । वृज् संभक्तौ । वृजशीङ्भ्यां रूपस्वांगयोरित्यसुन्त्ययः।
> पुगागमश्च । संभज्यते तदिति वर्पो रूपं। बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । हरितोः । हृञ् हरण
> इत्यस्मात् हृस्यरुहि युषिभ्य इतिः । उ. १–९९ ।

> इतीतिप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । भोजनं । भुज पालनाभ्यवहारयोरित्यस्मात्कृत्यल्युटो बहुलमिति कर्मणि ल्युट् । लित्स्वरः । अंतः । स्वरादिष्टंतोदात्तत्वेन पठितत्पादंतोदात्त, । चरत् । चरतिर्गत्यर्थः । लेटि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ॥

> *pṛthivīmadhārayat | haritorhariddarṇayoryayordyāvāpṛthivyormadhyè svakīyayoraśvayorbhūri prabhūtaṃ bhojanaṃ | bhujyata iti bhojanaṃ yavasādi | labhyate |*
> *yayośca vyāvāpṛthivyoraḥ tarmadhyè haririṃdraścarat | carati | te dyāvāpṛthivyāniṃdro 'dhārayadityartha: ‖ haridhāyasaṃ | ḍudhāṇ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasmādvahihāthāñchaṃdasītyasun | ṇudityanuvṛtterāto yuk | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | pṛthivīṃ | pratheḥ śivan saṃprasāraṇaṃ ceti pivantyayaḥ | ṣidgaurādibhyaścati jīṣ | pratyayasvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | harivarpasaṃ | vṛj saṃbhaktau | vṛjaśīṅbyāṃ rūpasvāṃgayorityasuntyayaḥ| pugāgamaśca | saṃbhajyate taditi varpo rūpaṃ| bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | haritoḥ | hṛñ haraṇa ityasmāt hṛsyaruhi yuṣibhya itiḥ | u. 1-99 | itītipratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | bhojanaṃ | bhuja pālanābhyavahārayorityasmātkṛtyalyuṭo bahulamiti karmaṇi lyuṭ | litsvaraḥ | aṃtaḥ | svarādiṣṭaṃtodāttatvena paṭhitatpādaṃtodātta, | carat | caratirgatyarthaḥ | leṭi rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

This Indra upheld the heaven that is हरिधायसं (*haridhāyasaṃ*): the green-hued supporters (dhāyasaḥ) of which are रत्नयो (*ratnayo*)[?30]. Likewise he upheld the earth, हरिवर्पसं (*harivarpasaṃ*), green with plants.

Between the two, heaven and earth, of green hue, his own two horses have abundant भोजनं (*bhojanaṃ*) (food), such as fodder, which is obtained; and between those same heaven and earth Hari, Indra, moves. The meaning is that Indra upheld those two, heaven and earth.

Word-to-word meaning

- ययोः (*yayoḥ*)—of which heaven and earth
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—throughout the middle

- हरिः (*hariḥ*)—Indra
- हरितोः (*haritoḥ*)—to his horses of green-tawny hue
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—abundant
- भोजनं (*bhojanaṃ*)—food such as fodder
- (he has) made; and ययोः अंतः (*yayoḥ aṃtaḥ*)—throughout the middle of which heaven and earth
- चरत् (*carat*)—he travels, such
- हरिधायसं (*haridhāyasaṃ*)—endowed with golden rays
- द्यां (*dyāṃ*)—the world of heaven
- हरिवर्पसं (*harivarpasaṃ*)—adorned with crops and emeralds
- पृथिवीं (*pṛthivīṃ*)—the earth
- आधारयत् (*ādhārayat*)—has lifted and held up (established)

Gist

He has lifted and held up the heaven endowed with golden rays and the earth adorned with crops and emeralds: the heaven and earth between which Indra has abundantly provided fodder and other food for his horses of green-tawny hue, and throughout the middle of which he travels. (He has created them.)

English translation

Indra has upheld the yellow-rayed heaven , the verdant tinted earth ; there is abundant pasture (for his steeds) in the two azure spheres of heaven and earth, between which Hari travels.

Special Topics

The greatness of Indra is described by saying that he is the cause of the mutual growth of prosperity of heaven and earth. The description हरिधायसं द्यां हरिवर्पसं पृथिवीं (*haridhāyasaṃ dyāṃ harivarpasaṃ pṛthivīṃ*) is poetic

and describes a principle of beauty; it is not merely a description of material wealth. The sky with its golden rays and the earth full of crops and emeralds, describing the beauty of the universe, make known the greatness of Indra, the primary cause of that beauty. Indra is the cause of the origin, the maintenance and the growth of heaven and earth.

Although हरिधायसं (*haridhāyasaṃ*) means "endowed with golden rays", wherever the words धायसे (*dhāyase*) and धायसा (*dhāyasā*) occur (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-95-1) the explanation is "supporting". The rays of the Sun support the universe. So the purport is "the rays of the Sun, which support the universe", and the meaning is the world of heaven endowed with such rays. Here the word हरि (*hari*) means golden. In the epithet हरिवर्पसं (*harivarpasaṃ*) the word हरि (*hari*) means emerald, and वर्पस् (*varpas*) means a radiant form. The earth has the epithet हरिवर्पसं (*harivarpasaṃ*) because it is endowed with world-attracting crops and emeralds. Indra has established heaven and earth, which are such nourishers of the world and endowed with world-attracting radiance.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ज॒ज्ञा॒नो हरि॑तो॒ वृषा॒ विश्व॒मा भा॑ति रोच॒नम् ।
हर्य॑श्वो॒ हरि॑तं धत्त॒ आयु॑ध॒मा वज्रं॑ बा॒ह्वोर्हरि॑म् ॥
४ ॥

> *jajñāno harito vṛṣā viśvamā bhāti rocanam |*
> *haryaśvo haritaṃ dhatta āyudhamā vajraṃ bāhvorharim ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> जज्ञानः । हरितः । वृषा । विश्वं । आ । भाति । रोचनं ।
> हरिऽश्वः । हरितं । धत्ते । आयुधं । आ । वज्रं । बाह्वोः । हरिं ॥ ४ ॥

> *jajñānaḥ | haritaḥ | vṛṣā | viśvaṃ | ā | bhāti | rocanaṃ |*
> *hari 'śvaḥ | haritaṃ | dhatte | āyudhaṃ | ā | vajraṃ | bāhvoḥ | hariṃ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषा कामानां वर्षको हरितो हरिद्वर्णोपेतो जज्ञानो जात इंद्रो
> विश्वं सर्वं रोचनं दीप्यमानं लोकमा भाति । सर्वतः प्रकाशयति । तथा हर्यश्व
> इंद्रो हरितं हरिद्वर्णोपेतमायुधं धत्ते । बाह्वोर्धत्ते । तथा हरिं शत्रूणां
> प्राणहारकं वज्रं बाह्वोराधत्ते ॥ जज्ञानः । जनी प्रादुर्भाव इत्यस्य लिटः कानच् ।
> गमहनेत्यादिनोपधालोपः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । भाति । भा दीप्ता वित्यस्यांतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य
> लटि रूपं । रोचनं । रुच दीप्तावित्यस्मादनुदात्तेतश्च हलादेरिति
> युच् । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । बाह्वोः । उदात्तयणो हल्पूर्नादिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *vṛṣā kāmānāṃ varṣako harito haridvarṇopeto jajñāno jāta iṃdro*
> *viśvaṃ sarvaṃ rocanaṃ dīpyamānaṃ lokamā bhāti | sarvataḥ prakāśayati | tathā haryaśva*
> *iṃdro haritaṃ haridvarṇopetamāyudhaṃ dhatte | bāhvordhatte | tathā hariṃ śatrūṇāṃ*
> *prāṇahārakaṃ vajraṃ bāhvorādhatte ‖ jajñānaḥ | janī prādurbhāva ityasya liṭaḥ kānac |*
> *gamahanetyādinopadhālopaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | bhāti | bhā dīptā vityasyāṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya laṭi rūpaṃ | rocanaṃ | ruca dīptāvityasmādanudāttetaśca halāderiti*
> *yuc | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | bāhvoḥ | udāttayaṇo halpūrnāditi vibhakterudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Indra, the showerer of desires, of green-tawny hue, being born, illumines on every side the whole shining world. Likewise Indra, lord of tawny horses, holds in his arms the weapon of tawny hue; and he holds in his arms the thunderbolt, हरिं (*hariṃ*), the taker of the lives of enemies.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषा (*vṛṣā*)—showerer of desires
- हरितः (*haritaḥ*)—of golden form; Indra
- बज्ञानः (*bajñānaḥ*)—as soon as born
- विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)—the entire
- रोचनं (*rocanaṃ*)—attractive world
- अ भाति (*a bhāti*)—he causes to shine

- हरश्वः (*haraśvaḥ*)—Indra, possessing horses named Hari
- हरितं (*haritaṃ*)—golden
- आयुधं (*āyudhaṃ*)—weapon
- धत्ते (*dhatte*)—holds
- हरिं (*hariṃ*)—that takes away (the lives of enemies)
- वज्रं (*vajraṃ*)—the thunderbolt weapon
- बाह्वोः (*bāhvoḥ*)—in his arms
- (अधत्ते) (*(adhatte)*)—holds

Gist

Indra, the showerer of desires, of golden form, causes the entire attractive world to shine as soon as he is born. Indra, possessor of the horses named Hari, holds a golden weapon. He holds in his arms the thunderbolt that takes away the lives of enemies.

English translation

The azure-coloured showerer (of benefits), illumes, as soon as born, the whole luminous region ; the lord of the tawny steeds holds in his hands the yellow weapon, the destroying thunderbolt.

Special Topics

When the greatness of Indra, the cause of the world's prosperity, is described, descriptions such as आयुधं धत्ते (*āyudhaṃ dhatte*) come along with it. Indra is a protector, and likewise a destroyer (of enemies). In the description that he makes the world attractive and radiant (विश्वं रोचनं आ भाति (*viśvaṃ rocanaṃ ā bhāti*)) and also lifts and holds a destructive weapon, the two forms of Indra are understood. The descriptions of Indra's thunderbolt, Viṣṇu's discus and Īśvara's trident are all of this kind. They are a harmony of protection and chastisement for the world, a harmony of truth and beauty. In their description a hidden spiritual principle is indicated. This principle of harmony will be discussed later, when the great nature of Indra's thunderbolt is explained.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्रो॑ ह॒र्यन्त॒मर्जु॑नं॒ वज्रं॑ शु॒क्रैर॒भीवृ॑तम् ।
अपा॑वृणो॒द्धरि॑भि॒रद्रि॑भिः सु॒तमुद्गा हरि॑भिराजत ॥ ५
॥

> *indro haryantamarjunaṃ vajraṃ śukrairabhīvṛtam |*
> *apāvṛṇoddharibhiradribhiḥ sutamudgā haribhirājata ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रः । हर्यंतं । अर्जुनं । वज्रं । शुक्रैः । अभिवृतं ।
> अप । अवृणोत् । हरिभिः । अद्रिभिः । सुतं । उत् । गाः । हरिभिः । आजत ॥ ५ ॥

> *iṃdraḥ | haryaṃtaṃ | arjunaṃ | vajraṃ | śukraiḥ | abhivṛtaṃ |*
> *apa | avṛṇot | haribhiḥ | adribhiḥ | sutaṃ | ut | gāḥ | haribhiḥ | ājata ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोऽयमिंद्रो हर्यंतं कमनीयमर्जुनं शुभ्रं । शुभ्रत्वमुपपादयति । शुक्रैः शुभैः क्षीरादिभिरभिवृतं व्याप्तं वज्रं वेगवंतं हरिभिः । हरंत्येभिः
> सोमरसानिति हरयः। तैरद्रिभिग्रावभिः सुतमभिषुतं सोममपावृणोत् । आवरणरहितमकरोत् । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । पूषा राजानमाघृणिरपगूळ्हं गुहा हितं
> अविंदत् । ऋग्वे. १–२३–१४ । इति । तथा गाः पणिभिरपहृता गा हरिभिरश्वैरुपेतः स इंद्र उदाजत । विलान्नि रगमयत् ॥ अर्जुनं । अर्ज षर्ज आर्जन इत्यस्मादर्जेर्णिलुक्चेत्युनन् । नित्स्वरः । अभिवृतं । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं । आजत । अज गतिक्षेपणयोः । लजि व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । निघातः ॥

> *so 'yamiṃdro haryaṃtaṃ kamanīyamarjunaṃ śubhraṃ | śubhratvamupapādayati | śukraiḥ śubhaiḥ kṣīrādibhirabhivṛtaṃ vyāptaṃ vajraṃ vegavaṃtaṃ haribhiḥ | haraṃtyebhiḥ*
> *somarasāniti harayaḥ| tairadribhigrāvabhiḥ sutamabhiṣutaṃ somamapāvṛṇot | āvaraṇarahitamakarot | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | pūṣā rājānamāghṛṇirapagūḷhaṃ guhā hitaṃ*
> *aviṃdat | ṛgve. 1-23-14 | iti | tathā gāḥ paṇibhirapahṛtā gā*

> *haribhiraśvairupetaḥ sa*
> *iṃdra udājata | vilānni ragamayat ‖ arjunaṃ | arja ṣarja ārjana*
> *ityasmādarjèrṇilukcetyunan | nitsvaraḥ | abhivṛtaṃ | gatiranaṃtara iti*
> *gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ | ājata | aja*
> *gatikṣepaṇayoḥ | laji vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

This Indra has uncovered the desirable (हर्यंतं (*haryaṃtaṃ*)) bright (अर्जुनं (*arjunaṃ*)) Soma. Sāyaṇa justifies the brightness: it is overlaid (अभिवृतं (*abhivṛtaṃ*)) with shining milk and the like; the vajra is swift. The हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*) are the stones by which the Soma juices are carried off (हरंत्येभिः (*haraṃtyebhiḥ*)); with these pressing stones he made the pressed Soma free of covering. The mantra text is cited: "Pūṣan found the king, hidden, placed in the cave" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-23-14). Likewise Indra, accompanied by his tawny horses, drove out the cows carried off by the Paṇis, making them come out of the cave. The grammatical remainder is omitted.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- हर्यंतं (*haryaṃtaṃ*)—attractive
- अर्जुनं (*arjunaṃ*)—bright
- शुक्रैः (*śukraiḥ*)—with pure milk and the like
- अभिवृतं (*abhivṛtaṃ*)—overlaid
- वज्रं (*vajraṃ*)—swift-flowing
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—pressing out the juice
- अद्रिभिः (*adribhiḥ*)—with stones
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—crushed and pressed, the Soma juice
- अपावृणोत् (*apāvṛṇot*)—released from concealment and made to appear shining
- गाः (*gāḥ*)—the cows (carried off by the Paṇis)
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—Indra, furnished with horses
- उत् अजत (*ut ajata*)—made them come out of the cave

Gist

Indra uncovered the Soma juice, which is attractive, bright, overlaid with pure milk and the like, swift-flowing, and crushed and pressed by the pressing stones, releasing it from concealment and making it appear shining. Indra, furnished with horses, made the cows carried off by the Paṇis come out of the cave.

English translation

Indra has uncovered the desirable white-coloured, fast-flowing Soma, effused by the expressing stones, and overlaid with the shining (milk and other liquids), in like manner as when, borne by his tawny steeds, he rescued the cattle

Special Topics

In this mantra the words arjuna, vajra and the rest are all epithets of the Soma juice. Arjuna is taken to mean bright; it is formed from the root raṃj, "to shine". In the Nirukta the word arjuna is read among the names of dawn (Ni. 1-8) and among the names of form (Ni. 3-7). The Nirukta author quotes

अहश्च कृष्णमहरर्जुनं च वि वर्तेते रजसी वेद्याभिः (*ahaśca kṛṣṇamahararjunaṃ ca vi vartete rajasī vedyābhiḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-9-1)

and explains kṛṣṇa as night and arjuna as the day of white colour. Also in भद्रा वस्त्राण्यर्जुना वसाना (*bhadrā vastrāṇyarjunā vasānā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-9-2) it indicates the bright colour of cloth. Thus the word serves not only where a merely physical matter is expressed but also where a spiritual principle is expressed. For example, the two names Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna may be said to reflect two principles of the Lord, the hidden and the manifest. All principles perceptible to the outer eye are indicated by the word arjuna; and Ṛgvedic passages describing the hidden principle, such as महत्तन्नाम गुह्यं (*mahattannāma guhyaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-55-1) and एकस्यदृशे न रूपं (*ekasyadṛśe na rūpaṃ*) (1-164-44), suggest the meaning of the Bhagavadgītā phrase गुह्याद्गुह्यतरं (*guhyādguhyataraṃ*). So the uses of kṛṣṇa and arjuna in the senses of hidden (secret) and perceptible (bright) convey a spiritual principle.

Vajra: explained as विवर्जयति प्राणान् (*vivarjayati prāṇān*), the thunderbolt having a destructive power. Its particulars were given earlier. In the present Ṛk it is used in the sense "swift-going".

Adribhiḥ: आद्रिरादृणात्येतेन । अपि वा अत्तेः सात् (*ādrirādṛṇātyetena | api vā atteḥ sāt*). The word adri is formed either from the root dṛ meaning "to split" or from the root ad meaning "to eat". It is used in many places as a synonym both for the stones that press Soma and for Indra's vajra. Its particulars are given in the Special Topics of Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-149-1, in the 11th volume of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā.

Sūkta 45 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> आ मंद्रॆरिति पंचर्चं सप्तमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं बार्हतमैंद्रं ; आ
> मंद्रॆरित्यनुक्रमणिका । पूर्वसूक्ते बार्हतं त्वित्युक्तत्वादस्यापि बार्हतत्वं ॥
> विशेषविनियोगस्तु यत्र श्रुत्या न सूत्रितः । स्मार्तं तत्र विजानीयादृग्विधानादि
> शास्त्रतः ॥
> अनुवादवु—आ मंद्रॆः ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि एळनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि ऐदु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु, इंद्रनु देवतॆयु, बृहती
> छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि आ मंद्रॆः ऎंदु मॊदलागि हेळिरुवुदु. हिंदिन सूक्तदल्लि
> हेळिरुवंतॆ बृहतीछंदस्सिन शस्त्रमंत्रगळिगागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदु. याव सूक्त
> अथवा मंत्रगळिगॆ शौतसूत्रादिगळल्लि विनियोगवु हेळल्पट्टिरुवुदिल्लवो अवुगळिगॆ स्मार्तप्रयोग
> गदल्लियू, शौनकोक्तवाद ऋग्विधानवॆंब ग्रंथदल्लि हेळिरुवंतॆयू, इतर शास्त्रगळल्लि हेळिरु
> वंतॆयू विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु भाविसबेकु.
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—४५
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—४५ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—९ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—५ ॥
> । ऋषिः— विश्वामित्र ।
> । देवता— इंद्र ।
> । छंदः— बृहती ।

> *ā maṃdrèriti paṃcarcaṃ saptamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ bārhatamaiṃdraṃ ; ā*
> *maṃdrèrityanukramaṇikā | pūrvasūkte bārhataṃ tvityuktatvādasyāpi bārhatatvaṃ ‖*
> *viśeṣaviniyogastu yatra śrutyā na sūtritaḥ | smārtaṃ tatra vijānīyādṛgvidhānādi*
> *śāstrataḥ ‖*
> *anuvādavu—ā maṃdrèḥ èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli eḷanèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli aidu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu, iṃdranu devatèyu, bṛhatī*
> *chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli ā maṃdrèḥ èṃdu mòdalāgi heḷiruvudu.*

> *hiṃdina sūktadalli*
> *heḷiruvaṃtè bṛhatīchaṃdassina śastramaṃtragaḷigāgi ī sūktada*
> *viniyogaviruvudu. yāva sūkta*
> *athavā maṃtragaḷigè śautasūtrādigaḷalli viniyogavu*
> *heḷalpaṭṭiruvudillavo avugaḷigè smārtaprayoga*
> *gadalliyū, śaunakoktavāda ṛgvidhānavèṃba graṃthadalli heḷiruvaṃtèyū,*
> *itara śāstragaḷalli heḷiru*
> *vaṃtèyū viniyogaviruvudèṃdu bhāvisabeku.*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—45*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—45 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—9 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—5 ‖*
> *| ṛṣiḥ— viśvāmitra |*
> *| devatā— iṃdra |*
> *| chaṃdaḥ— bṛhatī |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta आ मंद्रैः (*ā maṃdraiḥ*) has five Ṛks and is the seventh sūkta; seer Viśvāmitra, deity Indra; the Anukramaṇikā begins "ā mandraiḥ". Since the previous sūkta was said to be Bārhata, this one too is Bārhata. Where no specific use is given by Śruti-sūtra, one should know it from the Smārta rule, the Ṛgvidhāna and other śāstras.

भावार्थ (Bhāvārtha)

This sūkta, आ मंद्रैः (*ā maṃdraiḥ*), is the seventh in the fourth anuvāka. It has five Ṛks. Viśvāmitra is the seer, Indra the deity, Bṛhatī the metre. Its use is for the śastra mantras of Bṛhatī metre, as stated for the previous sūkta. For any sūkta or mantras whose use is not stated in the Śrauta-sūtras and the like, the use is to be understood as in the Smārta practice, in the Ṛgvidhāna attributed to Śaunaka, and in other śāstras.

Particulars

Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 45; Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Varga 9. Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 5. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: Indra. Metre: Bṛhatī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ म॒न्द्रैरि॑न्द्र॒ हरि॑भिर्या॒हि म॒यूर॑रोमभिः ।
मा त्वा॒ के चि॒न्नि यं॑म॒न्विं न पा॒शिनोऽति॒ धन्वे॑व॒
ताँ इ॑हि ॥ १ ॥

> *ā mandrairindra haribhiryāhi mayūraromabhiḥ |*
> *mā tvā ke cinni yamanviṃ na pāśino 'ti dhanveva tā~ ihi ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । मंद्रैः । इंद्र । हरिभिः । याहि । मयूररोमभिः ।
> मा । त्वा । के । चित् । नि । यमन् । विं । न । पाशिनः । अति । धन्वइव । तान् । इहि॥ १॥

> *ā | maṃdraiḥ | iṃdra | haribhiḥ | yāhi | mayūraromabhiḥ |*
> *mā | tvā | ke | cit | ni | yaman | viṃ | na | pāśinaḥ | ati | dhanvaiva | tān | ihi‖1‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र मंद्रैर्मादयितृभिर्मयूररोमभिर्मयूररोमसदृशरोमयुक्तैर्हरिभिरश्वैरुपेतस्त्वमा याहि । यज्ञं प्रत्यागच्छ । केचिदपि जनास्त्वा त्वां
>
> मा नि यमन् । मा नियच्छंतु । गमनप्रतिबंधं मा कुर्वंत्वित्यभिप्रायः । प्रतिबंधे दृष्टांतः । विं न । यथा पाशिनः पाशहस्ता व्याधा विं गच्छंतं दक्षिणं नियच्छंति तद्वन्मा नियच्छंतु । किंच धन्वेव । यथा पांथा धन्व मरुदेशं शीघ्रमतिगच्छंति । तद्वद्गमनप्रतिबंधकानतीत्य शीघ्रमिहि । आगच्छ ॥ मंद्रैः । मदि स्तुत्यादिश्वित्यस्य स्थायितंचीत्यादिना रक्षृत्ययः । इदित्तान्नुम् । प्रत्ययस्वरः । मयूररोमभिः । मयूररोमवद्रोमाणि येषामिति सप्तम्युपमानपूर्वपदस्य बहुव्रीहिरुत्तरपदलोपश्च । पा. २–२–२४–१२ । इति समास उत्तरपदलोपश्च । मयूरशब्दो मीनातेरूरन् । उ. १–६८ । इत्यूरन्प्रत्ययांतः । मीनाति सर्पानिति मयूरो बर्हि ।

> नित्वादाद्युदात्तत्वे प्राप्ते मादीनां । फि. ३–४ । इति सूत्रेण मध्योदात्तः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । यमन् यम उपरम इत्यस्य लेट्यडागमे रूपं । इहि । इण् गतावित्यस्य लोटि रूपं ॥

> *he iṃdra maṃdrairmādayitṛbhirmayūraromabhirmayūraromasadṛśaromayuktair haribhiraścairupetastvamā yāhi | yajñaṃ pratyāgaccha | kecidapi janāstvā tvāṃ mā ni yaman | mā niyacchaṃtu | gamanapratibaṃdhaṃ mā kurvaṃtvityabhiprāyaḥ | pratibaṃdhe dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | viṃ na | yathā pāśinaḥ pāśahastā vyādhā viṃ gacchaṃtaṃ dakṣiṇaṃ niyacchaṃti tadvanmā niyacchaṃtu | kiṃca dhanveva | yathā pāṃthā dhanva marudeśaṃ śīghramatigacchaṃti | tadvaddamanapratibaṃdhakānatītya śīghramihi | āgaccha ‖ maṃdrèḥ | madi stutyādiśvityasya sthāyitaṃcītyādinā rakṣṛtyayaḥ | idittānnum | pratyayasvaraḥ | mayūraromabhiḥ | mayūraromavadromāṇi yeṣāmiti saptamyupamānapūrvapadasya bahuvrīhiruttarapadalopaśca | pā. 2-2-24-12 | iti samāsa uttarapadalopaśca | mayūraśabdo mīnāterūran | u. 1-68 | ityūranpratyayāṃtaḥ | mīnāti sarpāniti mayūro barhi | nitvādādyudāttatve prāpte mādīnāṃ | phi. 3-4 | iti sūtreṇa madhyodāttaḥ | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | yaman yama uparama ityasya leṭyaḍāgame rūpaṃ | ihi | iṇ gatāvityasya loṭi rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, come to the sacrifice with your delighting horses, whose hair is like peacock hair. Let no persons restrain you." The example of restraint: as fowlers with snares in hand restrain a bird flying straight, let them not restrain you. Further, धन्वेव (*dhanveva*): as travellers quickly cross a desert, so pass beyond those who would hold you back and come quickly. Mayūra is derived from मीनाति सर्पानिति (*mīnāti sarpāniti*) ("he injures snakes"), the peacock. The grammatical remainder is omitted.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- मंद्रैः (*maṃdraiḥ*)—radiant

- मयूररोमभिः (*mayūraromabhiḥ*)—having hair attractive like peacock feathers
- हरिभिः (*haribhiḥ*)—you, joined with the horses
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—come to the sacrificial place
- पाशिनः (*pāśinaḥ*)—fowlers holding a net
- विं न (*viṃ na*)—as they stop a bird
- के चित् (*ke cit*)—let no one (on the way)
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- मा नि यमन् (*mā ni yaman*)—stop
- धन्वेव (*dhanveva*)—as travellers walk quickly to cross the obstacle of a desert
- तान् (*tān*)—(you also) the obstacles (on the way)
- अति (*ati*)—having crossed
- इहि (*ihi*)—come quickly

Gist

O Indra, come to our sacrificial place with horses that are radiant and have hair attractive like peacock feathers. As fowlers holding a net stop a bird

so let no one on the way stop you. As travellers walk quickly and cross a desert, so do you also cross the obstacles that may arise on the way and come quickly.

English translation

Come, Indra, with your exulting peacock-haired steeds; let no persons detain you as (fowlers) throwing snares catch a bird : pass them by (quickly) as (travellers cross) a desert.

Special Topics

In describing Indra's unobstructed power, his swiftness is compared to the unobstructed flight of a bird. There is another comparison, धन्वेव (*dhanveva*). The word dhanva is read in the Nirukta among the names of the atmosphere (Ni. 1-2) and among the names of motion (Ni. 4-2). Here it means motion; Indra's speed is compared to the swiftness of travellers in a desert.

In places such as धन्वचरो न वंसगस्तृषाणश्चकमानः (*dhanvacaro na vaṃsagastṛṣāṇaścakamānaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-36-1), dhanvacara is explained as a man who moves swiftly in a desert. Sāyaṇa sometimes explains it as a man who moves carrying a bow. Here the speed of motion and unobstructed power are indicated.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वृ॒त्र॒खा॒दो व॑लंरु॒जः पु॒रां द॒र्मो अ॒पाम॒जः ।
स्थाता॒ रथं॑स्य॒ हर्यो॑रभिस्व॒र इन्द्रो॑ दृ॒ळ्हा चिं॑दारु॒जः ॥ २ ॥

> *vṛtrakhādo valaṃrujaḥ purāṃ darmo apāmajaḥ |*
> *sthātā rathasya haryorabhisvara indro dṛḷhā cidārujaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वृत्रखादः । वलंरुजः । पुरां । दर्मः । अपां । अजः ।
> स्थाता । रथस्य । हर्योः । अभिस्वरे । इंद्रः । दृळ्हा । चित् । आरुजः ॥ २ ॥

> *vṛtrakhādaḥ | valaṃruja: | purāṃ | darmaḥ | apāṃ | aja: |*
> *sthātā | rathasya | haryoḥ | abhisvare | iṃdraḥ | dṛḷhā | cit | āruja: ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोऽयमिंद्रो वृत्रखादः । वृत्रं खादति हिनस्तीति वृत्रखादः । वलंरुजः ।
> वृणोश्याकाशमिति वलो मेघः । तस्य भंजकः । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । बिभेद वलं ।

> *so 'yamiṃdro vṛtrakhādaḥ | vṛtraṃ khādati hinastīti vṛtrakhādaḥ | valaṃruja: |*
> *vṛṇośyākāśamiti valo meghaḥ | tasya bhaṃjakaḥ | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | bibheda valaṃ |*

> ऋग्वे ३–३४–१० । इति । ततोऽपामजो मेघभेदनद्वारापां प्रेरकः पुरां शत्रुसंबंधिनां पुराणां दर्मो दारकः । तथा हर्योरश्वयोरभिस्वरेऽस्मदाभिमुख्येन
> प्रेरणे निमित्तभूते सति रथस्य स्थाता रथमधिष्ठाता । तथा दृळ्हा चित् दृढानामतिबलवतां

> शत्रूणामस्यारुजः समंताद्वंजको भवति ॥ वृत्रखादः । खादृ भक्षण इत्यस्मात्मर्मण्यण् । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । वलंरुजः । रुजो भंगे। कर्मण्युपपदे मूलविभुजादित्वात्कृत्ययः । तत्पुरुषे कृति बहुलमिति द्वितीयाया आलुक् । थाधादिस्वरः।
> आरुजः । रुजो भंग इत्यस्मादिगुपधलक्षणः कः । समासे थाधादिस्वरः ॥

> *ṛgve 3-34-10 | iti | tato 'pāmajo meghabhedanadvārāpāṃ prerakaḥ purāṃ śatrusaṃbaṃdhināṃ purāṇāṃ darmo dārakaḥ | tathā haryoraśvayorabhisvare 'smadābhimukhyena*
> *preraṇe nimittabhūte sati rathasya sthātā rathamadhiṣṭhātā | tathā dṛḷhā cit dṛḍhānāmatibalavatāṃ śatrūṇāmasyārujaḥ samaṃtādvaṃjako bhavati ‖ vṛtrakhādaḥ | khādṛ bhakṣaṇa ityasmātmarmaṇyaṇ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | valaṃrujaḥ | rujo bhaṃge| karmaṇyupapade mūlavibhujāditvātkṛtyayaḥ | tatpuruṣe kṛti bahulamiti dvitīyāyā āluk | thādhādisvaraḥ|*
> *ārujaḥ | rujo bhaṃga ityasmādigupadhalakṣaṇaḥ kaḥ | samāse thādhādisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

This Indra is vṛtrakhāda: he devours (injures) Vṛtra. Valaṃruja: vala is the cloud, since it covers the sky (the verb is vṛṇoti); he is its breaker. So the mantra text: "he split Vala"

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-34-10). Hence he is apāmaja, the impeller of the waters by splitting the cloud; darma, the tearer of the cities of the enemy. When his two horses are urged towards us (abhisvara), he is the stander on the chariot, its mounter. And he is the breaker on all sides of firm, very mighty enemies. The grammatical remainder is omitted.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृत्रखादः (*vṛtrakhādaḥ*)—slayer of Vṛtra
- वलंरुजः (*valaṃrujaḥ*)—splitter of the cloud
- अपामजः (*apāmajaḥ*)—sender down of water in the form of rain
- पुरां (*purāṃ*)—of enemy cities
- दर्मः (*darmaḥ*)—destroyer
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- हर्योः (*haryoḥ*)—his horses
- अभिस्वरे (*abhisvare*)—to urge to run towards us

- रथस्य (*rathasya*)—in his chariot
- स्थाता (*sthātā*)—sitting
- दृळ्हा चित् (*dṛḷhā cit*)—even the exceedingly mighty enemies
- आरुजः (*ārujaḥ*)—has the power to destroy

Gist

Indra, the slayer of Vṛtra, splitter of the cloud, sender down of water in the form of rain, destroyer of enemy cities, sits in his chariot to urge his horses to run towards us, and has the power to destroy even the exceedingly mighty enemies.

English translation

The devourer of Vritra, the fracturer of the cloud, the sender of the waters, the demolisher of cities. Indra, the destroyer of powerful enemies, has mounted his chariot to urge his horses to our presence.

Special Topics

The matters of Vala and Vṛtra were explained in detail earlier. Some hold that Vala and Vṛtra were brothers; they may also be understood as persons reflecting darkness. In the present Ṛk too, from वृणोतीति वलः (*vṛṇotīti valaḥ*) ("it covers the atmosphere"), the word vala is a synonym for cloud.

Abhisvare: the word abhisvara is used in different senses. Its particular meaning was given earlier in the Special Topics of Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-21. "अभिस्वर्तारो अर्कं न (*abhisvartāro arkaṃ na*)

The word अभिस्वर (*abhisvara*) is a synonym for the worshippers in passages such as सुष्टुभः (*suṣṭubhaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-78-4): those who all around (अभितः (*abhitaḥ*)) make the sound of praise in order to impel the gods. In the present context, as it is explained in passages such as चतुष्पादेति द्विपदामभिस्वरे संपश्यन् पंक्तिरुपतिष्ठमानः (*catuṣpādeti dvipadāmabhisvare saṃpaśyan paṃktirupatiṣṭhamānaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-117-8), the word अभिस्वर (*abhisvara*) can be taken to mean "approach"; the purport is "go towards". The purport is: to impel the horses to run towards us. The technical usages such as अभिस्वरंति (*abhisvaraṃti*) were also explained earlier.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ग॒म्भी॒राँ उ॑द॒धीँरि॑व॒ क्रतुं॑ पुष्यसि॒ गा इ॑व ।
प्र सु॑गो॒पा यव॑सं धे॒नवो॑ यथा ह्र॒दं कु॒ल्या इ॑वाशत ॥ ३ ॥

> *gambhīrā~ udadhī~riva kratuṃ puṣyasi gā iva |*
> *pra sugopā yavasaṃ dhenavo yathā hradaṃ kulyā ivāśata ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गंभीरान् । उदधीन् इव । क्रतुं । पुष्यसि । गाः इव ।
> प्र । सुगोपाः । यवसं । धेनवः । यथा । ह्रदं । कुल्याः इव । आशश ॥ ३ ॥

> *gaṃbhīrān | udadhīn iva | kratuṃ | puṣyasi | gāḥ iva |*
> *pra | sugopāḥ | yavasaṃ | dhenavaḥ | yathā | hradaṃ | kulyāḥ iva |*
> *āśaśa ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं गंभीरान्महावकाशानुदधीन् समुद्रानुदकैर्यथा पोषयसि
> तद्वत्कृतुं यज्ञस्य कर्तारमिमं यजमानमभिपुतफलप्रदानेन पुष्यसि । पोषयसि । अत्र दृष्टांतः ।
> यथा सुगोपाः सविचीनो गोपालो यवसेन गा:
> पोषयति तद्वत्।यथा धेनवो यवसं तृणादिकं प्राप्नुवंति तद्वत्त्वं सोमान्
> प्राप्नोषि । ते च सोमाः कुल्या इव कृत्रिमसरितो ह्लदं महाजलाशयं यथा
> प्राप्नुवंति तद्वत्वामाशत । व्याप्नुवंति ॥ गंभीरान् । गाध्य प्रतिष्ठालिप्सयोग्रंथे
> चेत्यस्माद्गंभीरगभीरावित्यनेन सूत्रेण इरच् प्रत्ययः । नुमागमोपधाह्रस्वभकाराः
> सर्वे निपात्यंते । चित्तादंतोदात्तः । उदधीनिव । उदकशब्द उपपदे दधातेरधिकरणेऽर्थे
> कर्मण्यधिकरणे चेति किप्रत्ययः । उदकशब्दस्य पेषंवासवाहनधिषु च ।
> पा. ६–३–५८ । इत्युदभावः । कृत्स्वरः । इवेन विभक्त्यलोपः । पुष्यसि । पुष
> पुष्टावित्यस्यांतर्णितण्यर्थस्य लटि रूपं । निघातः । सुगोपाः । गोपायतेः क्विपि रूपं ।
> यथा । यथेति पादांते : फि ४–१७ । इति निघातः । आतत । अशू व्याप्तानित्यस्माल्लजि
> बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । निघातः ॥

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ gaṃbhīrānmahāvakāśānudadhīn samudrānudakairyathā poṣayasi*
> *tadvatkṛtuṃ yajñasya kartāramimaṃ*
> *yajamānamabhiputaphalapradānena puṣyasi | poṣayasi | atra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | yathā sugopāḥ savicīno gopālo yavasena gā:*
> *poṣayati tadvat|yathā dhenavo yavasaṃ tṛṇādikaṃ prāpnuvaṃti tadvattvaṃ somān*
> *prāpnoṣi | te ca somāḥ kulyā iva kṛtrimasarito hradaṃ mahājalāśayaṃ yathā*
> *prāpnuvaṃti tadvatvāmāśata | vyāpnuvaṃti || gaṃbhīrān | gādhya pratiṣṭhālipsayograṃthe*
> *cetyasmādgaṃbhīragabhīrāvityanena sūtreṇa irac pratyayaḥ | numāgamopadhāhrasvabhakārāḥ*
> *sarve nipātyaṃte | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | udadhīniva | udakaśabda upapade dadhāteradhikaraṇe 'rthe karmaṇyadhikaraṇe ceti kipratyayaḥ | udakaśabdasya peṣaṃvāsavāhanadhiṣu ca |*
> *pā. 6-3-58 | ityudabhāvaḥ | kṛtsvaraḥ | ivena vibhaktyalopaḥ | puṣyasi | puṣa puṣṭāvityasyāṃtarṇitaṇyarthasya laṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | sugopāḥ | gopāyateḥ kvipi rūpaṃ |*
> *yathā | yatheti pādāṃte : phi 4-17 | iti nighātaḥ | ātata | aśū vyāptānityasmāllaji*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk | nighātaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Indra, as you nourish with waters the deep oceans of great extent, so you nourish this sacrificer, the doer (क्रतुं (*kratuṃ*)) of the sacrifice, by granting the fruit he desires. An illustration is given here: as a good herdsman, one who watches well, nourishes the cows with fodder; as cows obtain fodder, grass and the like, so you obtain the Soma-juices. And those Soma-juices reach you, as artificial channels reach a lake, a great reservoir of water. They pervade you."

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- गंभीरान् (*gaṃbhīrān*)—very deep

- उदधीन् इव (*udadhīn iva*)—(as you fill) the oceans (with waters)
- सुगोपाः (*sugopāḥ*)—an excellent herdsman
- गाः इव (*gāḥ iva*)—as (he) nourishes the cows
- क्रतुं (*kratuṃ*)—the sacrificer
- पुष्यसि (*puṣyasi*)—you nourish (with the granting of what he desires)
- यथा (*yathā*)—in the way in which
- धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*)—cows
- यवसं (*yavasaṃ*)—obtain fodder and the like (so you too obtain the Soma)
- कुल्याः इव (*kulyāḥ iva*)—as small rivers
- ह्रदं (*hradaṃ*)—reach a lake
- प्र आशत (*pra āśata*)—(those Soma-juices) reach your belly

Gist

O Indra, as you fill the very deep oceans with waters, and as an excellent herdsman nourishes the cows, so you nourish the sacrificer with the granting of what he desires. As cows abundantly obtain fodder and the like, so you too obtain the Soma. As small rivers reach a lake, so those streams of Soma-juice reach your belly.

English translation

You cherish the celebrator of the pious rite as (you fill) the deep seas (with water) ; or as a careful herdsman (cherishes) the cows ; (you imbibe the Soma) as cows (obtain) fodder, (and the juices flow into you) as rivulets flow into a lake.

Special Topics

Here the nature of the wealth that Indra provides for a sacrificer who performs good rites is described. Two aspects of this bestowal of wealth are given by way of comparison. This wealth is deep like the ocean. And the regard that Indra shows towards the sacrificer in this bestowal: both of these are possible only for an excellent sacrificer. In this Ṛk the word क्रतु (*kratu*) is a synonym for the sacrificer.

In the Ṛk-saṃhitā the word क्रतु (*kratu*) for the most part denotes the rite (karma); in some places it also denotes the aim of the rite. The deeper sense of this word has been explained in detail in the 13th part of the Ṛgveda-saṃhitā. Here, since it is a synonym for the sacrificer, it is used in a special sense. This word denotes both the sacrificer's aim and his power of action.

In the Saṃhitā and also in the Upaniṣads the two words क्रतु (*kratu*) and दक्ष (*dakṣa*) denote the person's power of will and power of action; or they may denote both the inner power and the outward action.

The Ṛk-saṃhitā explains in detail that if a person's wish or resolve is pure, then his practical capacity to obtain the human aim also grows.

इंद्रः सुतेषु सोमेषु क्रतुं पुनीत उक्थं (*iṃdraḥ suteṣu someṣu kratuṃ punīta ukthaṃ*)

विदे वृधस्य दक्षसो महान्हि षः (*vide vṛdhasya dakṣaso mahānhi ṣaḥ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-13-1)

Here, in वृधस्य दक्षसः विदे (*vṛdhasya dakṣasaḥ vide*), it is stated that in order to acquire strength that makes one grow, Indra purifies the sacrificer (his resolve), as in क्रतुं पुनीते (*kratuṃ punīte*). Even when the person's spiritual aim is explained, it is set out in sentences such as ओं क्रतो स्मर (*oṃ krato smara*) (Īśa. 17)[?31] and क्रतुमयःपुरुषः (*kratumayaḥpuruṣaḥ*) (Chā. U. 3-14-2). In such contexts Śaṅkarācārya has explained the word क्रतु (*kratu*) as resolution, or as the person's duty; the purport is resolve, and the power of action that accomplishes the resolve. According to this resolve and power the aim is accomplished. The nature of क्रतु (*kratu*) is stated thus: यथाक्रतुरस्मिल्लोके पुरुषो भवति तथेतः प्रेत्य भवति स क्रतुं कुर्वीत (*yathākraturasmilloke puruṣo bhavati tathetaḥ pretya bhavati sa kratuṃ kurvīta*) and so on. In the present Ṛk too the nature of the wealth that comes to such a person made of क्रतु (*kratu*) is described.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ न॒स्तुजं॑ र॒यिं भ॒राश॒ं न प्र॑तिजान॒ते ।
वृ॒क्षं प॒क्वं फल॑म॒ङ्कीव॑ धूनु॒हीन्द्र॑ स॒म्पार॑ण॒ं वसु॑ ॥
४ ॥

> *ā nastujaṃ rayiṃ bharāṃśaṃ na pratijānate |*
> *vṛkṣaṃ pakvaṃ phalamaṅkīva dhūnuhīndra sampāraṇaṃ vasu ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । नः । तुजं । रयिं । भर । अंशं । न । प्रतिजानते ।
> वृक्षं । पक्वं । फलं । अंकीऽइव । धूनुहि । इंद्र । संपारणं । वसु ॥ ४ ॥

> *ā | naḥ | tujaṃ | rayiṃ | bhara | aṃśaṃ | na | pratijānate |*
> *vṛkṣaṃ | pakvaṃ | phalaṃ | aṃkī 'iva | dhūnuhi | iṃdra | saṃpāraṇaṃ | vasu ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> –हे इंद्र नोऽस्माकं तुजं शत्रूणां बाधकं रयिं धनेनोपलक्षितं पुत्रमा भर । संपादय । तत्र दृष्टांतः । अंशं न ! यथा पिता प्रतिजानते व्यवहारज्ञाय पुत्राय स्वकीयस्य धनस्य भागं ददाति तद्वत् । किंच पक्वं फलं प्रति वृक्षमंकीवांकुशी यथा धूनोति तथा त्वं संपारणमस्मदच्छायाः सम्यक् पूरकं
> वसु धनं धूनुहि । चालय । प्रयच्छेत्यर्थः " प्रतिजानते । ज्ञा अवबोधन इत्यस्य

> *-he iṃdra no 'smākaṃ tujaṃ śatrūṇāṃ bādhakaṃ rayiṃ dhanenopalakṣitaṃ putramā bhara | saṃpādaya | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | aṃśaṃ na ! yathā pitā pratijānate vyavahārajñāya putrāya svakīyasya dhanasya bhāgaṃ dadāti tadvat | kiṃca pakvaṃ phalaṃ prati vṛkṣamaṃkīvāṃkuśī yathā dhūnoti tathā tvaṃ saṃpāraṇamasmadacchāyāḥ samyak pūrakaṃ*
> *vasu dhanaṃ dhūnuhi | cālaya | prayacchetyarthaḥ " pratijānate | jñā avabodhana ityasya*

> शतरि रूपं । प्रादिसमास– । शतुरनुम इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । धूनुहि । धूञ् कंपन इत्यस्य लोटि रूपं । संपारणं । प्प पालनपूरणयोरित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य करणे ल्युट् । समासे कृत्स्वर ॥

> *śatari rūpaṃ | prādisamāsa- | śaturanuma iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ |*
> *dhūnuhi | dhūñ kaṃpana*
> *ityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | saṃpāraṇaṃ | ppa pālanapūraṇayorityasya*
> *ṇyaṃtasya karaṇe lyuṭ |*
> *samāse kṛtsvara ||*

Summary

"O Indra, bring to us तुजं (*tujaṃ*), the harasser of enemies, रयिं (*rayiṃ*), that is, a son marked by wealth; provide him. An illustration: अंशं न (*aṃśaṃ na*), as a father gives a share of his own wealth to a son who knows how to manage affairs (प्रतिजानते (*pratijānate*)). Further: as a man with a hook (अंकी (*aṃkī*)) shakes a tree for the ripe fruit, so you shake down for us the wealth that is संपारणं (*saṃpāraṇaṃ*), that fully satisfies our wishes; that is, give it."

This block contains only Sāyaṇa's grammatical notes on the words of the Ṛk.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- प्रतिजानते (*pratijānate*)—to a son who has acquired knowledge of practical affairs
- अंशं न (*aṃśaṃ na*)—as a father gives a share of wealth
- नः (*naḥ*)—to me
- तुजं (*tujaṃ*)—harmful to enemies
- रयिं (*rayiṃ*)—wealth in the form of a son
- आ भर (*ā bhara*)—provide
- सक्वं (*sakvaṃ*)—ripe
- फलं (*phalaṃ*)—for the fruit
- अंकी (*aṃkī*)—a hook
- वृक्षं इव (*vṛkṣaṃ iva*)—as it shakes the tree (and provides the fruit)
- संपारणं (*saṃpāraṇaṃ*)—that gives us satisfaction

- वसु (*vasu*)—wealth
- धनुहि (*dhanuhi*)—make it move (make it reach us)

Gist

O Indra, as a father gives a share of wealth to a son who has acquired knowledge of practical affairs, provide us with a son who harasses enemies. As a hook shakes the tree for the ripe fruit and provides the fruit, set in motion the wealth that gives us satisfaction and provide it to us.

English translation

Grant us riches, securing (us against foes), (as a father bestows) his portion on (a son) arrived at maturity; send down upon us, Indra, wealth adequate (to our desires), as a crook brings down the ripe fruit from a tree.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk too there is a description of the wealth that comes to a person who knows the duty of sacrifice. The word तुजं (*tujaṃ*) is used in the sense of harming. In the Nirukta this word is listed among the names of the thunderbolt. It is also used in the sense of giving: तुजतिः दानकर्मा (*tujatiḥ dānakarmā*). In Ṛks such as भूं चिद्धि तुजशो मर्त्यस्य (*bhūṃ ciddi tujaśo martyasya*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-39-8) the generosity of the patron is described as "giver of much". In the present Ṛk too, when it says तुजं रयिं आ भर (*tujaṃ rayiṃ ā bhara*), it may be explained either as "provide the wealth of a son who harasses enemies" or as "give a generous son".

संपारणं (*saṃpāraṇaṃ*) is formed from the root पृ पालनतरणयोः (*pṛ pālanataraṇayoḥ*), "to protect" or "to carry across". It may mean wealth that protects from poverty, or that carries one across poverty and brings one to the end. In sum the purport is: what gives satisfaction.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्व॒युरि॑न्द्र स्व॒राळ॑सि॒ स्मद्दि॑ष्टि॒ः स्वय॑शस्तरः ।
स वा॑वृधा॒न ओज॑सा पुरुष्टु॒त भवा॑ नः सु॒श्रव॑स्तमः ॥ ५ ॥

> *svayurindra svarāḷasi smaddiṣṭiḥ svayaśastaraḥ |*
> *sa vāvṛdhāna ojasā puruṣṭuta bhavā naḥ suśravastamaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्वयुः। इंद्र । स्वराट् । असि । स्मर्त्॒दिष्टिः । स्वयशःतरः !
> सः । ववृधानः । ओजसा । पुरुस्तुत । भव । नः । सुश्रवःतमः ॥ ५ ॥

> *svayuḥ| iṃdra | svarāṭ | asi | smartdiṣṭiḥ | svayaśaḥtaraḥ !*
> *saḥ | vavṛdhānaḥ | ojasā | purustuta | bhava | naḥ | suśravaḥtamaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र स्वयुर्धनवानसि । तथा स्वराट् स्वर्गस्य राजासि । स्मद्दिष्टिर्भद्रवाक्यः
> स्वयशस्तरोऽतिशयेन प्रभूतकीर्तिरसि । हे पुरुष्टुत बहुभिराहूतेंद्र स त्वमोजसा बलेन
> वावृधानः वर्धमानः सन् नोऽस्मदर्थं सुश्रवस्तमोऽतिशयेन शोभनान्नोपेतो भव ॥ स्वयुः
> स्वशब्दान्मत्त्वर्थियो युः। स्वराट् । राज्य दीप्ता । क्विप् ।
> व्रश्चादिना षत्वं । स्मद्दिष्टिः । स्सत् सुमदित्यर्थे । उकारलोपश्कांदसः । बहुव्रीहौ
> पूर्वपदस्वरः । पुरुष्टुत । संहितायां स्तुतस्तोमयोश्च्ंदसीति षत्वं । भव ।
> भवतेर्लोटि रूपं । द्व्यचोऽतस्तिज इति संहितायां दीर्घः । सुश्रवस्तमः । श्रवः
> शब्दोऽसुनंतः । बहुव्रीहावाद्युदात्तं द्व्यच्छंदसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं। तदंतादतिशायने तमप् ।
> तस्य पित्तादनुदात्तत्वे बहुव्रीहिस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra svayurdhanavānasi | tathā svarāṭ svargasya rājāsi |*
> *smaddiṣṭirbhadravākyaḥ*
> *svayaśastaro 'tiśayena prabhūtakīrtirasi | he puruṣṭuta*
> *bahubhirāhūteṃdra sa tvamojasā balena vāvṛdhānaḥ vardhamānaḥ san*
> *no 'smadarthaṃ suśravastamo 'tiśayena śobhanānnopeto bhava ‖ svayuḥ*
> *svaśabdānmattvarthiyo yuḥ| svarāṭ | rājya dīptā | kvip |*

> *vraścādinā ṣatvaṃ | smaddiṣṭiḥ | ssat sumadityarthe |*
> *ukāralopaśkāṃdasaḥ | bahuvrīhau*
> *pūrvapadasvaraḥ | puruṣṭuta | saṃhitāyāṃ stutastomayoścaṃdasīti*
> *ṣatvaṃ | bhava |*
> *bhavaterloṭi rūpaṃ | dvyaco 'tastija iti saṃhitāyāṃ dīrghaḥ |*
> *suśravastamaḥ | śravaḥ*
> *śabdo 'sunaṃtaḥ | bahuvrīhāvādyudāttaṃ*
> *dvyacchaṃdasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ| tadaṃtādatiśāyane tamap |*
> *tasya pittādanudāttatve bahuvrīhisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, you are स्वयुः (*svayuḥ*), possessed of wealth; likewise स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*), king of heaven. You are स्मद्दिष्टिः (*smaddiṣṭiḥ*), of auspicious speech, and स्वयशस्तरः (*svayaśastaraḥ*), of exceedingly great fame. O पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*), Indra called upon by many, you, growing in strength (ओजसा (*ojasā*)), be for us सुश्रवस्तमः (*suśravastamaḥ*), most excellently endowed with good food." The rest of the block is grammatical.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- स्वयुः (*svayuḥ*)—(you) are possessed of wealth
- स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*)—lord of all heaven
- स्मद्दिष्टिः (*smaddiṣṭiḥ*)—of auspicious speech
- स्वयशस्तरः (*svayaśastaraḥ*)—exceedingly famous
- असि (*asi*)—you are
- पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)—O Indra, praised by many
- सः (*saḥ*)—you, of such greatness
- ओजसा (*ojasā*)—with strength
- वावृधानः (*vāvṛdhānaḥ*)—growing
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- सुश्रवस्तमः (*suśravastamaḥ*)—become an excellent giver of food

Gist

O Indra, you are possessed of wealth, lord of all heaven, of auspicious speech and exceedingly famous. O Indra, praised by many, you who have such greatness, growing in strength, become for us an excellent giver of food.

English translation

You are possessed of opulence, Indra; you are the lord of heaven, auspicious and renowend: may you who are adored of many, increasing in vigour, be to us a most (bountiful bestower) of food.

Special Topics

Here Indra's independence and sovereignty are described. The words स्वायुः (*svāyuḥ*) and स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) also indicate independence.

स्वयुः (*svayuḥ*)—This word is used in two places. In पशुर्नैति स्वयुरगोपाः (*paśurnaiti svayuragopāḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-4-7) it is explained as "one who moves about independently like an animal". In the present Ṛk it is explained as "one possessed of wealth". The purport lies in being without dependence on others and without subordination.

स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*)—It means one who is lord of himself. It can be taken as "self-luminous by his own greatness" or as "sovereign". This sovereignty is full of spiritual and moral principle. स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) also means one who is lord over himself. Considered from that point of view, it also means that a person who is lord over himself is fit to be lord of the world. This very point is stated in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa: the purport is that one who is to be lord of the world must have complete self-restraint, and must have self-independence without being subject to outward powers. In this word स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) a harmony of spiritual and Vedic practice is seen; the presence of a harmony of these two practices is the chief mark of Vedic culture. Besides this, the commentators have explained the word स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) as "king of heaven". In accordance with the śruti sentence स एक राजो जगतः (*sa eka rājo jagataḥ*), the meaning that Indra himself is king of this world and of heaven is described in many places in the Ṛgveda and the Yajurveda.

As described in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, the word स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) must combine both aspects, lord of oneself and lord of the world. The purport is that one who is not self-restrained cannot be a sovereign. In the present Ṛk the two words स्वयुः (*svayuḥ*) and स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) indicate these two special qualities of Indra. The meaning of the word स्वराट् (*svarāṭ*) can be stated from many points of view.

स्मद्दिष्टिः (*smaddiṣṭiḥ*)—It was stated earlier that the word स्मत् (*smat*) has the meanings beautiful, auspicious, propitious. दिष्टि (*diṣṭi*) is explained here as speech. The meaning is: one with auspicious speech. In Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-3-69[?32] and similar places it means "of pleasing sight".

Sūkta 46 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> युध्मस्य त इति पंचर्चमष्टमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रमैंद्रं । युद्धस्येत्यनुक्रमणिका ॥ दशरात्रे चतुर्थेऽहनि
> निष्केवल्ये युध्मस्य त इति सूक्तं निविद्धानं ।
> सूत्रितं च । कुह श्रुत इंद्रो युध्मस्य त इति निष्केवल्यं । आ. ७–११ । इति ॥
> ऋषभनाम्मेकाहेऽपि निष्केवल्यइदं सूक्तं निविद्धानं । सूत्रितं च । युध्मस्य त इति
> मध्यंदिनः । आ. ९–७ इति ॥

> *yudhmasya ta iti paṃcarcamaṣṭamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitramaiṃdraṃ |*
> *yuddhasyetyanukramaṇikā ‖ daśarātre caturthe 'hani niṣkevalye*
> *yudhmasya ta iti sūktaṃ nividvānaṃ |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | kuha śruta iṃdro yudhmasya ta iti niṣkevalyaṃ | ā. 7-11 |*
> *iti ‖ ṛṣabhanāmmekāhe 'pi niṣkevalyaidaṃ sūktaṃ nividvānaṃ |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | yudhmasya ta iti*
> *madhyaṃdinaḥ | ā. 9-7 iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn beginning युध्मस्य ते (*yudhmasya te*) is a group of five ṛks, the eighth hymn. It is by Viśvāmitra and addressed to Indra (the Anukramaṇikā: युद्धस्य (*yuddhasya*)). Use: on the fourth day of the Daśarātra, at the Niṣkevalya, the hymn युध्मस्य ते (*yudhmasya te*) serves as the nivid-hymn. The sūtra is: कुह श्रुत इंद्रो युध्मस्य त इति निष्केवल्यं (*kuha śruta iṃdro yudhmasya ta iti niṣkevalyaṃ*) (Ā. 7-11). In the one-day rite called Ṛṣabha as well, this hymn is the nivid-hymn at the Niṣkevalya. The sūtra is: युध्मस्य त इति मध्यंदिनः (*yudhmasya ta iti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-7).

Anuvāda

This hymn, "Yudhmasya te", is the eighth hymn in the fourth anuvāka. It has five ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, its deity Indra, its metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā begins with "Yudhmasya". When the Niṣkevalya śastra mantras are recited on the fourth day of the sacrifice called Daśarātra, the ṛks of this hymn are used for the nivid mantras; this is stated by the Āśvalāyana-śrautasūtra, in the sūtra

"Kuha śruta Indro yudhmasya ta iti niṣkevalyam" (Ā. 7-11). It is likewise explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana-śrautasūtra, "Yudhmasya ta iti madhyandinaḥ" (Ā. 9-7), that in the one-day sacrifice called Ṛṣabhanāman the ṛks of this hymn are used for the nivid mantras of the Niṣkevalya śastra.

Particulars

Hymn 46. Maṇḍala 3, Anuvāka 4, Sūkta 46. Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 3, Varga 10. Number of the book (Ṛks) in the hymn: 5. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: Indra. Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यु॒ध्मस्य॑ ते वृष॒भस्य॑ स्व॒राज॑ उ॒ग्रस्य॒ यून॒ः स्थवि॑रस्य॒ घृष्वे॑ः ।
अजू॑र्यतो व॒ज्रिणो॑ वी॒र्या॒३॑णीन्द्र॑ श्रु॒तस्य॑ मह॒तो म॒हानि॑ ॥ १ ॥

> *yudhmasya te vṛṣabhasya svarāja ugrasya yūnaḥ sthavirasya ghṛṣveḥ |*
> *ajūryato vajriṇo vīryāṇīndra śrutasya mahato mahāni ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> युध्मस्य । ते । वृषभस्य । स्वराजः । उग्रस्य । यूनः । स्थविरस्य । फृष्टेः ।
> अजूर्यतः । वज्रिणः । वीर्याणि । इंद्र । श्रुतस्य । महतः । महानि ॥ १ ॥

> *yudhmasya | te | vṛṣabhasya | svarājaḥ | ugrasya | yūnaḥ | sthavirasya | phṛṣṭeḥ |*
> *ajūryataḥ | vajriṇaḥ | vīryāṇi | iṃdra | śrutasya | mahataḥ | mahāni ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र युध्मस्य योधनशीलस्य वृषभस्याभिमतफलसेचकस्य स्वराजो धनाधिपतेरुग्रस्य
> समर्थस्य यूनो नित्यतरुणस्य स्थविरस्य चिरंतनस्य घृष्टेः शत्रूणां
> संघर्षकस्याजूर्यतो जरारहितस्य वज्रिणः श्रुतस्य त्रिषु लोकेषु प्रसिद्धस्य अत
> एव महतस्ते तव वीर्याणि महानि । महांति खलु ॥ युध्मस्य । युध संप्रहारे ।
> इषियुधींधिदसीत्यादिना मक्प्रत्ययः । यूनः । यौतेः कनिन्युवृषीत्यादिना कनिन्।
> श्वयुवमघोनामतद्धित इति संप्रसारणं । नित्स्वरः । स्थविरस्य ।
> अजिरशिशिरशिथिलेत्यादिना किरन्प्रत्ययांतो । निपातितः । घृष्टेः । घृषु संघर्षे ।
> कृविघृष्टिच्छवीत्यादिना
> क्विन्प्रत्ययांतो निपात्यते । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he iṃdra yudhmasya yodhanaśīlasya vṛṣabhasyābhimataphalasecakasya svarājo dhanādhipaterugrasya samarthasya yūno nityataruṇasya sthavirasya ciraṃtanasya ghṛṣṭeḥ śatrūṇāṃ*
> *saṃgharṣakasyājūryato jarārahitasya vajriṇaḥ śrutasya triṣu lokeṣu prasiddhasya ata*
> *eva mahataste tava vīryāṇi mahāni | mahāṃti khalu ‖ yudhmasya | yudha saṃprahāre |*
> *iṣiyudhīṃdhidasītyādinā makpratyayaḥ | yūnaḥ | yauteḥ kaninyuvṛṣītyādinā kanin|*
> *śvayuvamaghonāmataddhita iti saṃprasāraṇaṃ | nitsvaraḥ | sthavirasya | ajiraśiśiraśithiletyādinā kiranpratyayāṃto | nipātitaḥ | ghṛṣṭeḥ | ghṛṣu saṃgharṣe | kṛvighṛṣṭicchavītyādinā*
> *kvinpratyayāṃto nipātyate | nittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, your heroic deeds are great: you are युध्मस्य (*yudhmasya*), given to fighting; वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*), the sprinkler of the desired fruit; स्वराजः (*svarājaḥ*), lord of wealth; उग्रस्य (*ugrasya*), capable; यूनः (*yūnaḥ*), ever young; स्थविरस्य (*sthavirasya*), ancient; घृष्टेः (*ghṛṣṭeḥ*), the grinder-down of enemies; अजूर्यतः (*ajūryataḥ*), free of old age; वज्रिणः (*vajriṇaḥ*), bearer of the thunderbolt; श्रुतस्य (*śrutasya*), famed in the three worlds. Therefore, being great, your heroic deeds are great; for they are indeed mighty. The remainder of the block gives derivations and accent notes on yudhmasya, yūnaḥ, sthavirasya and ghṛṣṭeḥ.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- युद्धस्य (*yuddhasya*)—of the excellent warrior
- वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*)—of the showerer of desires
- स्वराजः (*svarājaḥ*)—of the lord of all wealth
- उग्रस्य (*ugrasya*)—of the fearsome
- यूनः (*yūnaḥ*)—of the young
- स्थविरस्य (*sthavirasya*)—(at the same time) of the aged (the ancient)
- फृष्टैः (*phṛṣṭaiḥ*)—of him who crushes enemies
- अजूरतः (*ajūrataḥ*)—of him free from old age (decrepitude)
- वज्रिणः (*vajriṇaḥ*)—of the holder of the thunderbolt
- श्रुतस्य (*śrutasya*)—of him famed in the three worlds
- महतः (*mahataḥ*)—of him who is therefore endowed with greatness
- ते (*te*)—your
- वीर्याणि (*vīryāṇi*)—deeds of valour
- महानि (*mahāni*)—are most wonderful

Gist

O Indra, excellent warrior, showerer of desires, lord of all wealth, young and ancient, crusher of enemies, free from old age, holder of the thunderbolt: for that very reason you are endowed with greatness, and your deeds of valour are most wonderful.

English translation

Vast are the energies of you, Indra, the warrior, (the showerer of benefits), the lord of wealth, the fierce; you are (both) young and old; the overcomer of foes, the undecaying, the wielder of the thunderbolt; and you are mighty and renowned.

Special Topics

ते वीर्याणि महानि (*te vīryāṇi mahāni*)—In praising your heroic deeds as most wonderful, the verse also describes together with them the great qualities needed for such deeds. Earlier, "अहन्नहिमन्वपस्तर्द प्र वक्षणा

अभिनत्पर्वतानां ; आत्सूरं जनयन्दामुषासं (*ahannahimanvapastarda pra vakṣaṇā abhinatparvatānām ; ātsūraṃ janayandāmuṣāsaṃ*)" (Indra split the cloud, made a way for the streams flowing in the mountains, and created the sun, the dawn and the firmament for their light), and so on, describing Indra's valour, the glory of Indra was described with "इंद्रस्य नु वीर्याणि प्रवोचं (*iṃdrasya nu vīryāṇi pravocaṃ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-32). The fighting capacity, fierceness and self-rule useful for such great deeds are described in the present ṛk.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हाँ अ॑सि महि॒ष वृष्ण्ये॑भिर्धन॒स्पृदु॑ग्र॒ सह॑मानो अ॒न्यान् ।
एको॒ विश्व॑स्य॒ भुव॑नस्य॒ राजा॒ स यो॒धया॑ च क्ष॒यया॑ च॒ जना॑न् ॥ २ ॥

> *mahā~ asi mahiṣa vṛṣṇyebhirdhanaspṛdugra sahamāno anyān |*
> *eko viśvasya bhuvanasya rājā sa yodhayā ca kṣayayā ca janān ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महान् । असि । महिष । वृष्ण्येभिः । धनस्पृत् । उग्र । सहमानः । अन्यान् ।
> एकः । विश्वस्य । भुवनस्य । राजा । सः । योधय । च । क्षयय । च । जनान् ॥ २ ॥

> *mahān | asi | mahiṣa | vṛṣṇyebhiḥ | dhanaspṛt | ugra | sahamānaḥ | anyān |*
> *ekaḥ | viśvasya | bhuvanasya | rājā | saḥ | yodhaya | ca | kṣayaya | ca | janān ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे महिष महनीय उग्र इंद्र त्वं महानसि । धनस्पृत् धनानि दानभोगत्यागैः पारं नयंस्त्वं
> वृष्ट्येभिर्वीरैरन्यान् । शत्रून्सहमानोऽभिभवन्वर्तसे । तथा
> विश्वस्य सर्वस्य भुवनस्यैकोऽसहायो राजा स त्वं योधय च । ससत्नान् प्रहर ।
> जनान् क्षयय च । निवासय । बाधकान्हत्वा साधुजनान् स्वस्थाने स्थापयेत्यभिप्रायः ॥
> महिष । मह पूजायां । अविमहोष्टिषच् । उ. १–४६ । इति टिषच्–

> *he mahiṣa mahanīya ugra iṃdra tvaṃ mahānasi | dhanaspṛt dhanāni*
> *dānabhogatyāgaiḥ pāraṃ nayaṃstvaṃ vṛṣṭyebhirvīrairanyān |*
> *śatrūnsahamāno 'bhibhavanvartase | tathā*
> *viśvasya sarvasya bhuvanasyaiko 'sahāyo rājā sa tvaṃ yodhaya ca |*
> *sasatnān prahara |*
> *janān kṣayaya ca | nivāsaya | bādhakānhatvā sādhujanān svasthāne*
> *sthāpayetyabhiprāyaḥ ‖ mahiṣa | maha pūjāyāṃ | avimahoṣṭiṣac | u.*
> *1-46 | iti ṭiṣac-*

> प्रत्ययः । आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः । वृष्ट्येभिः । वृष्टि भवानि भवे छंदसीति यत् ।
> यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तः । योधय । युध संप्रहार इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लोटि
> रूपं । चादिषु चेति न निघातः । णित्स्वरः । क्षयय । क्षिनिवासगत्योरित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य
> लोटि रूपं । अत्रापि पूर्ववदनिघातः ॥

> *pratyayaḥ | āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ | vṛṣṭyebhiḥ | vṛṣṭi bhavāni bhave*
> *chaṃdasīti yat |*
> *yato 'nāva ityādyudāttaḥ | yodhaya | yudha saṃprahāra ityasya*
> *ṇyaṃtasya loṭi*
> *rūpaṃ | cādiṣu ceti na nighātaḥ | ṇitsvaraḥ | kṣayaya |*
> *kṣinivāsagatyorityasya ṇyaṃtasya*
> *loṭi rūpaṃ | atrāpi pūrvavadanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Mahiṣa (worshipful), fierce Indra, you are great. As धनस्पृत् (*dhanaspṛt*) you carry riches across (to the far shore) by giving, enjoying and relinquishing them. With वृष्ट्येभिः (*vṛṣṭyebhiḥ*), with heroes, you overpower other enemies. You are the sole, unaided king of the whole world. Such as you, fight, and make the people dwell: slay the obstructors and settle good people in their own place, is the intention. The derivation of महिष (*mahiṣa*) is from mah, "to worship", with the suffix ṭiṣac (Uṇ. Sū. 1-46).

This block continues with grammatical remarks (suffix, accent) on mahiṣa, vṛṣṭyebhiḥ, yodhaya and kṣayaya.

Word-to-word meaning

- महिष (*mahiṣa*)—venerable one
- उग्र (*ugra*)—fierce Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- महान् असि (*mahān asi*)—you are of great form
- धनस्पृत् (*dhanaspṛt*)—you show wealth its uses such as giving
- वृष्ट्येभिः (*vṛṣṭyebhiḥ*)—by your valorous powers
- अन्यान् (*anyān*)—enemies
- सहमानः (*sahamānaḥ*)—you are the defeater
- विश्वस्य (*viśvasya*)—of all
- भुवनस्य (*bhuvanasya*)—the world
- एकः (*ekaḥ*)—alone
- राजा (*rājā*)—you are lord
- सः (*saḥ*)—such as you
- योधय च (*yodhaya ca*)—fight (our enemies and defeat them)
- जनान् (*janān*)—the people who perform sacrifice
- क्षयय चे (*kṣayaya cè*)—make them possessors of dwellings

Gist

O worshipful and fearsome Indra, you are of great form. You show wealth its uses such as giving, and you defeat enemies by your valorous powers. You alone are lord of the whole world. Such as you, fight our enemies and defeat them, and give houses and other dwellings to the human sacrificers and protect them.

English translation

Adorable and powerful Indra, you are great and magnificent, overcoming adversaries by your prowess ; you alone are lord of all the world ; war (upon our enemies), and give safe dwellings to men.

Special Topics

महिष (*mahiṣa*)—The word mahiṣa is read among the names for "great" in the Nirukta (Ni. 3-3). It means venerable, or else the accomplisher of great deeds. The Nirukta-author quotes the ṛk "अपामुपस्थे महिषा... (*apāmupasthe mahiṣā...*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-8-4) and there explains this word as "deep". The intention here is that Indra's personal power is deep. In this power there is a blending of both beauty and terror(?).[?33]For that reason the epithet उग्र (*ugra*) is fitting. Hence, without giving here the meaning "sprinkler" for the word वृष्णेभिः (*vṛṣṇebhiḥ*), it is shown that it is used in the sense of "power": वृष्णेभिः (*vṛṣṇebhiḥ*) means "by powers that accomplish great deeds".

As described in the Aitareya-brāhmaṇa, Indra, once consecrated, obtained the rank of self-rule. The description "भुवनस्य एकः राजाः (*bhuvanasya ekaḥ rājāḥ*)" shows the point that there is no other lord of the world than him. Or else this description also shows that there is no other illuminator of the world than Indra, who is of the nature of the sun.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र मात्रा॑भी रिरिचे॒ रोच॑मान॒ः प्र दे॒वेभि॑र्वि॒श्वतो॒ अप्र॑तीतः ।
प्र म॒ज्मना॑ दि॒व इन्द्र॑ः पृथि॒व्याः प्रोरोर्म॒हो अ॒न्तरि॑क्षादृजी॒षी ॥ ३ ॥

> *pra mātrābhī ririce rocamānaḥ pra devebhirviśvato apratītaḥ |*
> *pra majmanā diva indraḥ pṛthivyāḥ prorormaho antarikṣādṛjīṣī ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । मात्राभिः । रिरिचे । रोचमानः । प्र । देवेभिः । विश्वतः । अप्रतिइत ।
> प्र । मज्मना । दिवः । इंद्रः । पृथिव्याः । प्र । उरोः । महः । अंतरिक्षात् । ऋजीषी॥

> *pra | mātrābhiḥ | ririce | rocamānaḥ | pra | devebhiḥ | viśvataḥ | apratiita |*
> *pra | majmanā | divaḥ | iṃdraḥ | pṛthivyāḥ | pra | uroḥ | mahaḥ | aṃtarikṣāt | ṛjīṣī‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> रोचमानो दीप्यमानो विश्वतः सर्वैरप्रतीत एतावदस्य सामर्थ्यमित्यपरिच्छिद्यमान यजीषी सोमवानिंद्रो मात्राभिः । मीयंते परिच्चिद्यंत इति मात्राः
> शिलोच्चयाः । तेभ्योऽपि प्र रिरिचे । प्रकर्षण महत्तयातिरिक्कोऽभूत् । तथा
> देवेभिर्देवेभ्योऽपि मज्ञना । मज्ञयति शत्रोन्मुखसागर इति मज्ञ बलं । तेन
> बलेन प्ररिरिचे । तथा दिवः पृथिव्या द्यावापृथिवीभ्यां च प्ररिरिचे । तथोरोर्विस्तीर्णान्महो महतोंतरिक्षादपि प्ररिरिचे॥ मात्राभिः माज् माने शब्द चेत्यस्मात्
> हुयामाश्रुभसिभ्यस्त्रन्निति त्रन्प्रत्ययः । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । ढ्रलोपे पूर्वस्य
> दीर्घोऽण इति संहितायां दीर्घः । रोचमानः । रुच दीप्ताविति‍यस्मात् शानचि
> रूपं । तस्य लसार्वधातुकस्वरे धातुस्वरः । अप्रतीतः। इण् गतौ । कर्मणि क्तः। प्रादिसमासः । नञा समासे तस्य स्वरः । मज्ञना । टुमस्टो शुद्धौ । औणादिको मनिच्प्रत्ययः । झलां झश् झशीति जत्त्वं । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । पृथिव्याः । उदात्तयणो हल्पूर्वादिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *rocamāno dīpyamāno viśvataḥ sarvairapratīta etāvadasya sāmarthyamityaparicchidyamāna yajīṣī somavāniṃdro mātrābhiḥ | mīyaṃte pariccidyaṃta iti mātrāḥ*
> *śiloccayāḥ | tebhyo 'pi pra ririce | prakarṣaṇa mahattayātirikko 'bhūt | tathā*
> *devebhirdevebhyo 'pi majjanā | majjayati śatronmukhasāgara iti majja balaṃ | tena*
> *balena praririce | tathā divaḥ pṛthivyā dyāvāpṛthivībhyāṃ ca praririce | tathororvistīrṇānmaho mahatoṃtarikṣādapi praririce‖ mātrābhiḥ māj māne śabda cetyasmāt*
> *huyāmāśrubhasibhyastranniti tranpratyayaḥ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ | ḍhralope pūrvasya*
> *dīrgho 'ṇa iti saṃhitāyāṃ dīrghaḥ | rocamānaḥ | ruca dīptāvityasmāt śānaci*
> *rūpaṃ | tasya lasārvadhātukasvare dhātusvaraḥ | apratītaḥ| iṇ gatau | karmaṇi ktaḥ| prādisamāsaḥ | nañā samāse tasya svaraḥ | majjanā | ṭumasṭo śuddhau | auṇādiko manicpratyayaḥ | jhalāṃ jhaś jhaśīti jattvaṃ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | pṛthivyāḥ | udāttayaṇo halpūrvāditi vibhakterudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Indra, shining, not fully known by all ("this much is his power"), the Soma-possessor, has surpassed the मात्राः (*mātrāḥ*). These are things that are measured and bounded, namely rock-heaps (शिलोच्चयाः (*śiloccayāḥ*)); he has exceeded even these, becoming greatly excessive. Likewise he has surpassed even the gods by मज्जना (*majjanā*), that is by strength: majja is strength, because it plunges (मज्जयति (*majjayati*)) into the face of the sea of enemies. By that strength he has surpassed; so too heaven and earth, and the vast, great firmament. The rest of the block gives derivations and accent notes (mātrābhiḥ, rocamānaḥ, apratītaḥ, majjanā, pṛthivyāḥ).[?34]

Word-to-word meaning

- रोचमानः (*rocamānaḥ*)—shining
- विश्वतः (*viśvataḥ*)—by all people (by anyone)
- अप्रतीतः (*apratītaḥ*)—one who cannot be measured
- ऋजीषीः (*ṛjīṣīḥ*)—Soma-possessing
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- मात्राभिः (*mātrābhiḥ*)—than all beings
- प्र रिरिचे (*pra ririce*)—has grown with greater measure
- मज्मना (*majmanā*)—by power
- देवेभिः (*devebhiḥ*)—than the gods
- प्र (*pra*)—he is greater
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—than the heavenly world
- पृथिव्याः (*pṛthivyāḥ*)—than the earth
- प्र रिरिचे (*pra ririce*)—he is greater
- उरोः (*uroḥ*)—than the wide
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—and great
- अंतरिक्षात् (*aṃtarikṣāt*)—than the firmament
- प्र (रिरिचे) (*pra (ririce)*)—he is exceedingly greater

Gist

Indra, shining, immeasurable by anyone, and Soma-possessing, has grown with greater measure than all beings. In power he is greater than the gods. He is exceedingly greater than the firmament, which is wider and greater than the earth.

English translation

The resplendent and every way unlimited Indra, drinking the spiritless Soma juice, far surpasses the elements, (far exceeds) the gods in power; he is more vast than heaven and earth, or the widespread spacious firmament.

Special Topics

Indra's immeasurable nature is described here. The meaning is that he is greater than all things that are bounded, that is, that come within man's measure; in other words he is not an object that comes within man's measure.

मात्राभिः (*mātrābhiḥ*)—As explained earlier in Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-38-3, here too it is explained: "मीयंते मांतीति वा मात्रा: शिलोच्चयाः (*mīyaṃte māṃtīti vā mātrā: śiloccayāḥ*)". It is formed from the root mā, meaning "to measure". Although it applies to all things possessing limit, here it is explained as lofty rock-heaps. When describing the nature of all the elements such as earth, the Upaniṣads use this word thus: "पृथिवी च पृथिवीमात्रा चापश्चापोमात्राच तेजश्चतेजोमात्रा च वायुश्च नायुमात्रा च आकाशश्चाकाशमात्रा ॥ (*pṛthivī ca pṛthivīmātrā cāpaścāpomātrāca tejaścatejomātrā ca vāyuśca nāyumātrā ca ākāśaścākāśamātrā* ‖)" (Praśne. 4-8).[?35] In the quoted sentence the word mātrā has the technical meaning tanmātra ("subtle element"). Here there is no room for a philosophical discussion; in sum, they may be called things confined to the limits of man. The intention is that Indra has grown beyond all these.

ऋजीषी (*ṛjīṣī*)—This epithet is because he is accompanied by Soma. It is used chiefly in describing the nature of Indra and the Maruts. In such contexts as "अमत्रेभिर्यजीषिणिमिंद्रं (*amatrebhiryajīṣiṇimiṃdraṃ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-42-2)[?36] the word ṛjīṣa is explained as power; it is explained as "of Indra, who has obtained power that obstructs enemies". But in many contexts this epithet is well known precisely because he is accompanied by Soma.

As in "अणोरणीयान् महतो महीयान् (*aṇoraṇīyān mahato mahīyān*)", here too Indra's greatness is described by "उरोः महः अंतरिक्षात् प्र रिरिचे (*uroḥ mahaḥ aṃtarikṣāt pra ririce*)". Since Indra reflects all principles such as Vāyu and Āditya, it may be said that the supreme principle described in the Upaniṣads is at times regarded in the Saṃhitā in the form of Indra. This point will be explained later in the description of the spiritual nature of Indra and the other deities.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒रुं ग॑भी॒रं ज॒नुषा॒भ्यु॒१॑ग्रं वि॒श्वव्य॑चसमव॒तं म॑ती॒नाम् ।
इन्द्र॒ं सोमा॑सः प्र॒दिवि॑ सु॒तास॑ः समु॒द्रं न स्र॒वत॒ आ विं॑शन्ति ॥ ४ ॥

> *uruṃ gabhīraṃ januṣābhyugraṃ viśvavyacasamavataṃ matīnām |*
> *indraṃ somāsaḥ pradivi sutāsaḥ samudraṃ na sravata ā viśanti ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उरुं । गभीरं । जनुषा । अभि । उग्रं । विश्वव्यचसं । अवतं । मतीनां ।
> इंद्रं । सोमासः । प्रदिवि । सुतासः । समुद्रं । न । स्रवतः । आ । विशंति ॥ ४ ॥

> *uruṃ | gabhīraṃ | januṣā | abhi | ugraṃ | viśvavyacasaṃ | avataṃ | matīnāṃ |*
> *iṃdraṃ | somāsaḥ | pradivi | sutāsaḥ | samudraṃ | na | sravataḥ | ā | viśaṃti ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उरुं महांतं आत एव गभीरं महावकाशं जनुषा जन्मना स्वभावत एवोग्रं
> शत्रूणां भयंकरं । गभीरत्वमेवोच्यते । विश्वव्यचसं विश्वव्याप्तं मतीनां
> स्तुतीनां स्तोत्कणां वावतं रक्षकं तादृशनिंद्रं प्रदिवि पूर्वष्टहःसु सुतासो
> ग्रावभिरभिषुताः सोमासः सोमा अभि आभिमुख्येना विशंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः ।
> समुद्रं न । यथा स्रवतः स्रवंत्यो नद्यः समुद्रमाविशंति तद्वत् ॥ जनुषा । जनी
> प्रादुर्भाव इत्यस्माज्जनेरुसिरित्युसिप्रत्ययः । विश्वव्यचसं ! व्यच वाजीकरण इत्यस्मादसुन् ।
> व्यचेः कुटादित्वमनसीति वक्तव्यमिश्यत्रानसीति पर्युदासात् जित्वाभावः ।
> बहुव्रीहौ विश्वं संज्ञायामिति पूर्वपदस्यांतोदात्तत्वं । अवतु । अव
> रक्षणादिषु । औणादिकोऽतच् प्रत्ययः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *uruṃ mahāṃtaṃ āta eva gabhīraṃ mahāvakāśaṃ januṣā janmanā svabhāvata evograṃ*
> *śatrūṇāṃ bhayaṃkaraṃ | gabhīratvamevocyate | viśvavyacasaṃ viśvavyāptaṃ matīnāṃ*
> *stutīnāṃ stotkaṇāṃ vāvataṃ rakṣakaṃ tādṛśaniṃdraṃ pradivi pūrvaṣṭahaḥsu sutāso*
> *grāvabhirabhiṣutāḥ somāsaḥ somā abhi ābhimukhyenā viśaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *samudraṃ na | yathā sravataḥ sravaṃtyo nadyaḥ samudramāviśaṃti tadvat ‖ januṣā | janī*
> *prādurbhāva ityasmājjanerusirityusipratyayaḥ | viśvavyacasaṃ ! vyaca vājīkaraṇa ityasmādasun | vyaceḥ kuṭāditvamanasīti*
> *vaktavyamiśyatrānasīti paryudāsāt jitvābhāvaḥ |*
> *bahunrīhau viśvaṃ saṃjñāyāmiti pūrvapadasyāṃtodāttatvaṃ | avatu | ava*
> *rakṣaṇādiṣu | auṇādiko 'tac pratyayaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

Indra is उरुं (*uruṃ*), great, and therefore गभीरं (*gabhīraṃ*), of great expanse; जनुषा (*januṣā*), by birth, by nature, fierce, terrifying to enemies. (Only depth is meant.) He is विश्वव्यचसं (*viśvavyacasaṃ*), all-pervading, and the protector (अवतं (*avataṃ*)) of the praises, or of the praisers. To such an Indra the Somas, pressed with the stones in प्रदिवि (*pradivi*), the earlier days, enter from the front. The illustration: समुद्रं

न (*samudraṃ na*), as flowing rivers enter the ocean, so they. The rest of the block gives derivations and accent notes (januṣā, viśvavyacasam, avatam).

Word-to-word meaning

- उरुं (*uruṃ*)—one of vast form
- गभीरं (*gabhīraṃ*)—one with an unfathomable belly
- जनुषा (*januṣā*)—naturally (from birth itself)
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—terrible to enemies
- विश्वव्यचसं (*viśvavyacasaṃ*)—all-pervading
- मतीनां (*matīnāṃ*)—to the praises
- अवतं (*avataṃ*)—the protector
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra (accusative)
- प्रदिवि (*pradivi*)—on former days
- सुतासः (*sutāsaḥ*)—pressed
- सोमासः (*somāsaḥ*)—the Soma juices
- स्रवतः (*sravataḥ*)—flowing rivers
- समुद्रं न (*samudraṃ na*)—as they enter the deep sea
- अभि (*abhi*)—towards Indra's belly
- आ विशंति (*ā viśaṃti*)—enter, flowing

Gist

As long-flowing rivers enter the unfathomable sea, the Soma juices pressed on former days enter Indra, who is of vast form, who has an unfathomable belly, who is naturally terrible to enemies, all-pervading, and the protector of the praises.

English translation

The Soma juices daily poured out enter into the vast and profound Indra, fierce from his birth, all-pervading, the protector of the pious (wor- shippers), as rivers flow into the sea.

Special Topics

As described in the previous Ṛk, here too Indra's all-pervasiveness is described. In such contexts सोमासः (*somāsaḥ*) cannot be given merely the sacrificial-procedure meaning "Soma juice"; moreover the simile

स्रवतः समुद्रं न (*sravataḥ samudraṃ na*) conveys an extraordinary meaning in such contexts. What is Indra's belly? How does a flow of Soma run there? One must examine what common quality there is between this vast form and the form described by the epithet विश्वव्यचसं (*viśvavyacasaṃ*). Examining the extraordinary qualities of Indra described earlier and those to be described later, it must be decided further on whether the principle of Indra is identical with the principle of the Supreme Brahman described in the Upaniṣads and the like, or whether, as modern scholars hold, Indra is a deity subject to a lower principle.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यं सोम॑मिन्द्र पृथि॒वीद्यावा॒ गर्भं॒ न मा॒ता बिं॑भृ॒तस्त्वा॒या ।
तं तें॑ हिन्वन्ति॒ तमु॑ ते मृजन्त्यध्व॒र्यवों॑ वृषभ॒ पात॒वा उं॑ ॥ ५ ॥

> *yaṃ somamindra pṛthivīdyāvā garbhaṃ na mātā bibhṛtastvāyā |*
> *taṃ te hinvanti tamu te mṛjantyadhvaryavo vṛṣabha pātavā u ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यं । सोमं । इंद्र । प्रधिवीद्यावा । गर्भं । न । माता । बिभृतः । त्वाया ।
> तं । ते । हिन्वंति । तं । ऊं इति । ते । मृजंति । अध्वर्यवः । वृषभ । पातवै ।
> ऊं इति ॥ ५ ॥

> *yaṃ | somaṃ | iṃdra | pradhivīdyāvā | garbhaṃ | na | mātā | bibhṛtaḥ | tvāyā |*
> *taṃ | te | hinvaṃti | taṃ | ūṃ iti | te | mṛjaṃti | adhvaryavaḥ |*
> *vṛṣabha | pātavai |*
> *ūṃ iti ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र पृथिवीद्यावा द्यावापृथिव्य त्वाया त्वत्कामनया यं सोमं
> बिभृतोऽंतर्धारयतः । अत्र दृष्टांतः । गर्भ० न । यथा माता गर्भ० बिभर्ति तद्वत्
> हे वृषभ कामानां वर्षक हे इंद्र अध्वर्यवोऽध्वरं यजमानायेच्छंतस्ते
> त्वदर्थ० तं सोमं हिन्वंति । प्रेरयंति । किंच ते तव पातवै पानाय तं सोमं
> मृजंति । शोधयंति । उ प्रसिद्धौ ॥ पृथिवीद्यावा । दिवो द्यावेति द्यावादेशः ।
> आद्युदात्तः । नोत्तरपदेऽनुदात्तादावपृथिवीरुद्रपूषमंथिष्यत्र पर्युदासाद्देवताद्वंद्व
> चेत्युभयपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । कृतसमासस्य विपर्यासश्छांदसः । बिभृतः ।
> डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्माल्लट भृञामिदित्यभ्यासस्येत्वं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ।
> अजादिप्रत्ययपरत्वाभावादत्राभ्यस्तानामादिरिति स्वरो न भवति । प्रत्ययस्वरः । त्वाया ।
> त्वामिच्छतीत्यर्थे सुप आत्मनः क्यच् । पूर्वपददकारस्याकारश्छांदसः।
> अ प्रत्ययादिति भावेऽप्रत्ययः । सुपां सुलुगिति तृतीयायाः सवर्णदीर्घः । एकादेशस्वरः ।
> अध्वर्यवः । अध्वरमिच्छंतः । सुपः क्यच् । कव्यध्वरपृतनस्यर्चि लोप
> इत्याकारलोपः । क्याच्छंदसीत्युप्रत्ययः। प्रत्ययस्वरः । पातवै । पा पाने। तुमर्थे
> तवैप्रत्ययः । अंतश्च तवै युगपदिति धात्वंतस्य प्रत्ययस्य चोदात्तत्वं । उञ् इति
> प्रगृह्यसंज्ञा ॥

> *he iṃdra pṛthivīdyāvā dyāvāpṛthivya tvāyā tvatkāmanayā yaṃ somaṃ*
> *bibhṛto 'ṃtardhārayataḥ | atra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | garbhao na | yathā mātā*
> *garbhao bibharti tadvat*
> *he vṛṣabha kāmānāṃ varṣaka he iṃdra adhvaryavo 'dhvaraṃ*
> *yajamānāyecchaṃtaste*
> *tvadarthao taṃ somaṃ hinvaṃti | prerayaṃti | kiṃca te tava pātavai*
> *pānāya taṃ somaṃ*
> *mṛjaṃti | śodhayaṃti | u prasiddhau ‖ pṛthivīdyāvā | divo dyāveti*
> *dyāvādeśaḥ |*
> *ādyudāttaḥ | nottarapade 'nudāttādāvapṛthivīrudrapūṣamaṃthiṣyatra*
> *paryudāsāddevatādvaṃdva cetyubhayapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ |*
> *kṛtasamāsasya viparyāsaśchāṃdasaḥ | bibhṛtaḥ |*
> *ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasmāllaṭa bhṛñāmidityabhyāsasyètvaṃ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *ajādipratyayaparatvābhāvādatrābhyastānāmādiriti svaro na bhavati |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ | tvāyā | tvāmicchatītyarthe supa ātmanaḥ kyac |*
> *pūrvapadadakārasyākāraśchāṃdasaḥ|*
> *a pratyayāditi bhāve 'pratyayaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti tṛtīyāyāḥ*
> *savarṇadīrghaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ | adhvaryavaḥ | adhvaramicchaṃtaḥ |*

> *supaḥ kyac | kavyadhvarapṛtanasyarci lopa*
> *ityākāralopaḥ | kyācchaṃdasītyupratyayaḥ| pratyayasvaraḥ | pātavai |*
> *pā pāne| tumarthe*
> *tavaipratyayaḥ | aṃtaśca tavai yugapaditi dhātvaṃtasya pratyayasya*
> *codāttatvaṃ | uñ iti*
> *pragṛhyasaṃjñā ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, the Heaven and Earth, out of desire for you (त्वाया (*tvāyā*), "wishing you"), hold within themselves the Soma." Here is the example: गर्भ० न (*garbhao na*)—as a mother carries the embryo. "O Indra, showerer (वृषभ (*vṛṣabha*)) of desires, the Adhvaryus, desiring the sacrifice for the sacrificer, impel (हिन्वंति (*hinvaṃti*), "send forth") that Soma for you. Moreover they purify (मृजंति (*mṛjaṃti*)) that Soma for your drinking (पातवै (*pātavai*))." उ (*u*) is a particle of well-known (emphatic) sense.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- माता (*mātā*)—the mother
- गर्भं न (*garbhaṃ na*)—as she carefully protects and bears her child in the womb with affection
- पृथिवीद्यावा (*pṛthivīdyāvā*)—Heaven and Earth both
- त्वाया (*tvāyā*)—with reference to you
- यं सोमं (*yaṃ somaṃ*)—which Soma
- बिभृतः (*bibhṛtaḥ*)—they hold
- तं (*taṃ*)—that same Soma
- वृषभ (*vṛṣabha*)—O Indra, showerer of desires
- अध्वरवः (*adhvaravaḥ*)—the Adhvaryus?[37]
- ते (*te*)—for you
- हिन्वंति (*hinvaṃti*)—press and hold
- ते (*te*)—your
- पातनै (*pātanai*)—for drinking?[38]
- तं (*taṃ*)—that Soma
- मृजंति (*mṛjaṃti*)—they purify

Gist

O Indra, showerer of desires, as a mother carefully protects and bears her child in her womb, so Heaven and Earth both hold for you the Soma; in the same way the Adhvaryus hold Soma for you. For your drinking they purify that same Soma.

English translation

Which Soma, Indra, the heaven and earth contain for you, as a mother contains the embryo; showerer (of benefits), the priests pour it out for you they purify it for your drinking.

Special Topics

As indicated in the previous Ṛk, it is understood that here too the word सोम (*soma*) must have a special meaning. As described in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa (11-5-9-10-11), it can be understood as a special radiance that gives beauty to creative power; or it may be a special essence that is the cause of that radiance. The god Soma is also of the form of Āditya, lord of radiance (Śa. Brā. 11-5-9). In the contexts where it is said that Soma is offered to Soma himself, the same kind of special meaning must be given. There is a hidden meaning in the statement that Heaven and Earth hold Soma for the increase of Indra: just as Heaven and Earth, fundamental to the world's functioning, are the cause of the increase of Indra's radiance, so the Adhvaryus too are the cause. This purport is stated on the basis of the above-cited passage of the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa.

Sūkta 47 (Maṇḍala 3)

The forty-seventh sūkta.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> मरुत्वानिति पंचर्चं नवमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभमैंद्रं । मरुत्वानित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥ दशरात्रे
> चतुर्थेऽहनि मरुत्वतीयशस्त्र एतत्तूक्तं निविद्धानीयं ।
> सूत्रितं च । श्रुधी हवमिंद्र मरुत्वा इंद्रेति मरुत्वतीयं । आ. ७–११ । इति ॥
> ऋषभनाम्न्यकाहेऽपि मरुत्वतीयशस्त्र एतन्निविद्वानं । सूत्रितं च । मरुत्वा इंद्र
> युध्मस्य त इति मध्यंदिनः । आ. ९–७ । इति ॥

> *marutvāniti paṃcarcaṃ navamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ*
> *traiṣṭubhamaiṃdraṃ | marutvānityanukramaṇikā ‖ daśarātre caturthe*
> *'hani marutvatīyaśastra etattūktaṃ nividdhānīyaṃ |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | śrudhī havamiṃdra marutvā iṃdreti marutvatīyaṃ | ā.*
> *7-11 | iti ‖*
> *ṛṣabhanāmnyakāhe 'pi marutvatīyaśastra etannividvānaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca*
> *| marutvā iṃdra*
> *yudhmasya ta iti madhyaṃdinaḥ | ā. 9-7 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*) has five Ṛks; it is the ninth sūkta (of the anuvāka), by Viśvāmitra, in the Triṣṭubh metre, addressed to Indra; the Anukramaṇikā says "मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*)". In the Daśarātra, on the fourth day, this sūkta is used at the Marutvatīya śastra as the one carrying the nivid. The sūtra says: श्रुधी हवमिंद्र मरुत्वा इंद्रेति मरुत्वतीयं (*śrudhī havamiṃdra marutvā iṃdreti marutvatīyaṃ*) (Ā. 7-11). In the one-day rite named Ṛṣabha also, this is the nivid-bearing sūkta at the Marutvatīya śastra; the sūtra says: मरुत्वा इंद्र युध्मस्य त इति मध्यंदिनः (*marutvā iṃdra yudhmasya ta iti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-7).

> अनुवादवु—– मरुत्वान् ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि ऒंभत्तनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि ऐदु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्के विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु, इंद्रनु देवतॆयु, त्रिष्टुप्
> छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि मरुत्वान् ऎंदु मॊदलागि हेळिरुवुदु दशरात्रवॆंब यागद
> नाल्कनॆय दिवस मरुत्वतीयशस्त्रमंत्रपठनकालदल्लि ई सूक्तवन्नु निविन्मंत्रगळिगागि उपयोगि
> सबेकॆंदु अश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—–श्रुधी हवमिंद्र मरुत्वा इंद्रेति मरुत्वतीयं ऎंब

सूत्रदिंदलू (आ. ७–११), ऒंदु दिवसमात्र माडल्पड्डुव ऋषभनाम्मियॆंब यागदल्लि मरु
त्वतीयशस्त्रमंत्रगळन्नु पठिसुवाग निविन्मंत्रगळिगागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु आश्वलायन
शौतसूत्रद—मरुत्वा इंद्र युध्मस्य त इति मध्यंदिनः ऎंब सूत्रदिंदलू (आ. ९–७)
विवृतवागिरुवुदु.
॥ ओं ॥
सूक्त—४७
मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—४७ ॥
अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—११ ॥
॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—५ ॥
, ऋषिः— विश्वामित्रः
। देवता— इंद्रः ।
। छंदः — त्रिष्टुप् ।

anuvādavu— marutvān èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli
òṃbhattanèya sūktavu.
idaralli aidu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu, iṃdranu
devatèyu, triṣṭup
chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli marutvān èṃdu mòdalāgi heḷiruvudu
daśarātravèṃba yāgada
nālkanèya divasa marutvatīyaśastramaṃtrapaṭhanakāladalli ī
sūktavannu nivinmaṃtragaḷigāgi upayogi
sabekèṃdu aśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—śrudhī havamiṃdra marutvā
iṃdreti marutvatīyaṃ èṃba
sūtradiṃdalū (ā. 7-11), òṃdu divasamātra māḍalpaḍuva
ṛṣabhanāmmiyèṃba yāgadalli maru
tvatīyaśastramaṃtragaḷannu paṭhisuvāga nivinmaṃtragaḷigāgi ī sūktada
viniyogaviruvudèṃdu āśvalāyana
śautasūtrada—marutvā iṃdra yudhmasya ta iti madhyaṃdinaḥ èṃba
sūtradiṃdalū (ā. 9-7)
vivṛtavāgiruvudu.
‖ oṃ ‖
sūkta—47
maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—47 ‖
aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—11 ‖
‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—5 ‖

> *, ṛṣiḥ— viśvāmitraḥ*
> *| devatā— iṃdraḥ |*
> *| chaṃdaḥ — triṣṭup |*

Anuvāda: This sūkta beginning "Marutvān" is the ninth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka and has five Ṛks. Viśvāmitra is its seer, Indra the deity, Triṣṭubh the metre. The Anukramaṇikā begins with "Marutvān". It is to be used for the nivid mantras at the time of reciting the Marutvatīya śastra mantras on the fourth day of the sacrifice called Daśarātra, as stated by the Āśvalāyana-Śrautasūtra "श्रुधी हवमिंद्र मरुत्वा इंद्रेति मरुत्वतीयं (*śrudhī havamiṃdra marutvā iṃdreti marutvatīyaṃ*)" (Ā. 7-11); and in the sacrifice called Ṛṣabhanāmnī, performed in a single day, the use of this sūkta for the nivid mantras while reciting the Marutvatīya śastra mantras is explained by the Āśvalāyana-Śrautasūtra "मरुत्वा इंद्र युध्मस्य त इति मध्यंदिनः (*marutvā iṃdra yudhmasya ta iti madhyaṃdinaḥ*)" (Ā. 9-7). Particulars: Sūkta 47; Maṇḍala 3, Anuvāka 4, Sūkta 47; Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 3, Varga 11; number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 5; Ṛṣi: Viśvāmitra; Devatā: Indra; Chandas: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒रुत्वाँ इन्द्र वृष॒भो रणा॑य॒ पिबा॒ सोम॑मनुष्व॒धं मदा॑य ।
आ सिं॑ञ्चस्व ज॒ठ॒रे मध्वं॑ ऊ॒र्मिं त्वं राजा॑सि प्र॒दिव॑◌ः सु॒ताना॑म् ॥ १ ॥

> *marutvā~ indra vṛṣabho raṇāya pibā somamanuṣvadhaṃ madāya |*
> *ā siñcasva jaṭhare madhva ūrmiṃ tvaṃ rājāsi pradivaḥ sutānām || 1 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> मरुत्वान् । इंद्र । वृषभः । रणाय । पिज । सोमं । अनुस्वधं । मदाय ।
> आ । सिंचस्व । जठरे । मध्वः । उर्मिं । त्वं । राजा । असि । प्रदिवः । सुतानां ॥ १ ॥

> *marutvān | iṃdra | vṛṣabhaḥ | raṇāya | pija | somaṃ | anusvadhaṃ | madāya |*
> *ā | siṃcasva | jaṭhare | madhvaḥ | urmiṃ | tvaṃ | rājā | asi | pradivaḥ | sutānāṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र यो वृषभोऽपां वर्षिता मरुत्वान् । मरुतो देवविशस्तद्वान् ।
> स त्वमनुष्वधं स्वधया सवनीयपुरोडाशादिरूपेणान्नेनानुगतं सोमं रणाय
> रमणीयसंग्रामार्थं मदाय तं सोमं पिब । किंच मध्यो मदकॆरस्य सोमस्त्योर्मि संघातं बहुरसं
> जठरे । जग्धमन्नमस्मिंस्तिष्ठतीति जठरमुदरं । तस्मिन्नुदर आ सिंचस्व । सर्वतः क्षारय ।
> यतस्त्वं प्रदिवः पूर्वेष्वहःसु सुतानामभिषुतानां सोमानां राजासीशितासि । न
> केवलमधुनातनानामिति भावः । उक्तमर्थं
> यास्को ब्रवीति । मरुत्वानिंद मरुद्भिस्तद्वान् वृषभो वर्षितापां रणाय
> रमणीयाय संग्रामाय पिब सोममनुष्वधमन्वन्नं मदाय मदनीयाय
> जैत्रायासिंच स्वजठरे मधुन ऊर्मि० । मधु सोममित्यौपमिकं माद्यतेरिदमपीतरन्मध्वतस्मादेव
> । त्वं राजासि पूर्वेष्वस्यहःसु सुतानां । नि. ४–८ । इति ॥
> अनुस्वधं । स्वधामनुगम्य वर्तमानं । अत्यादयः क्रांताद्यर्थे द्वितीययेति
> समासः । संहितायां पूर्वपदात् । पा. ८–३–१०६ । इति षत्वं । निरुदकादित्वादंतोदात्तत्वं
> । ऊर्मि० । अर्तेरुच्चेति मिप्रत्ययः धातोरू इत्यादेशो रपरः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra yo vṛṣabho 'pāṃ varṣitā marutvān | maruto devaviśastadvān |*
> *sa tvamanuṣvadhaṃ svadhayā*
> *savanīyapuroḍāśādirūpeṇānnenānugataṃ somaṃ raṇāya*
> *ramaṇīyasaṃgrāmārthaṃ madāya taṃ somaṃ piba | kiṃca madhyo*
> *madakèrasya somastyormi saṃghātaṃ bahurasaṃ jaṭhare |*
> *jagdhamannamasmiṃstiṣṭhatīti jaṭharamudaraṃ | tasminnudara ā*
> *siṃcasva | sarvataḥ kṣāraya | yatastvaṃ pradivaḥ pūrveṣvahaḥsu*
> *sutānāmabhiṣutānāṃ somānāṃ rājāsīśitāsi | na*
> *kevalamadhunātanānāmiti bhāvaḥ | uktamarthaṃ*
> *yāsko bravīti | marutvāniṃda marudbhistadvān vṛṣabho varṣitāpāṃ raṇāya*
> *ramaṇīyāya saṃgrāmāya piba somamanuṣvadhamanvannaṃ madāya madanīyāya*
> *jaitrāyāsiṃca svajaṭhare madhuna ūrmio | madhu somamityaupamikaṃ*
> *mādyateridamapītaranmadhvatasmādeva | tvaṃ rājāsi*
> *pūrveṣvasyahaḥsu sutānāṃ | ni. 4-8 | iti ‖*

> *anusvadhaṃ | svadhāmanugamya vartamānaṃ | atyādayaḥ*
> *krāṃtādyarthe dvitīyayeti*
> *samāsaḥ | saṃhitāyāṃ pūrvapadāt | pā. 8-3-106 | iti ṣatvaṃ |*
> *nirudakāditvādaṃtodāttatvaṃ | ūrmio | artèrucceti mipratyayaḥ*
> *dhātorū ityādeśo raparaḥ |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"O Indra, you who are the showerer (वृषभ (*vṛṣabha*)) of waters and मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*)—possessed of the Maruts, the divine clan—drink that Soma, which is accompanied (अनुस्वधं (*anusvadhaṃ*)) by स्वधा (*svadhā*), that is, by food in the form of the puroḍāśa and the like of the pressing, for the delightful (रणाय (*raṇāya*)) battle and for exhilaration (मदाय (*madāya*)). Moreover, pour the wave (ऊर्मिं (*ūrmiṃ*), the collected mass, abundant juice) of the intoxicating sweet Soma into your belly (जठरे (*jaṭhare*); the belly is so called because the food eaten stays in it); pour it in all around. For you are the lord of the Somas pressed on former days (प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*))—not only of the present ones." Yāska states the same meaning: मरुत्वानिंद मरुद्भिस्तद्वान् वृषभो वर्षितापां रणाय रमणीयाय संग्रामाय पिब सोममनुष्वधमन्वन्नं मदाय मदनीयाय जैत्रायासिंच स्वजठरे मधुन ऊर्मि० । मधु सोममित्यौपमिकं माद्यतेरिदमपीतरन्मध्वतस्मादेव । त्वं राजासि पूर्वेष्वस्यहःसु सुतानां । (*marutvāniṃda marudbhistadvān vṛṣabho varṣitāpāṃ raṇāya ramaṇīyāya saṃgrāmāya piba somamanuṣvadhamanvannaṃ madāya madanīyāya jaitrāyāsiṃca svajaṭhare madhuna ūrmio | madhu somamityaupamikaṃ mādyateridamapītaranmadhvatasmādeva | tvaṃ rājāsi pūrveṣvasyahaḥsu sutānāṃ* |) (Ni. 4-8).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—you who pour down rain
- मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*)—who are accompanied by the Maruts
- अनुष्वधं (*anuṣvadhaṃ*)—accompanied by food in the form of svadhā
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- रणाय (*raṇāya*)—in battle

- मदाय (*madāya*)—for increasing your valour
- पिब (*piba*)—drink
- मध्वः (*madhvaḥ*)—of the intoxicating Soma
- ऊर्मि (*ūrmi*)—the essence in the form of a wave
- जठरे (*jaṭhare*)—in your belly
- आ सिंचस्व (*ā siṃcasva*)—pour fully
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—on former days
- सुतानां (*sutānāṃ*)—of all the pressed Somas
- राजा (*rājā*)—as lord
- असि (*asi*)—you are

Gist

O Indra, you who pour down rain and are accompanied by the Maruts, drink the Soma accompanied by food in the form of svadhā, in battle, to increase your valour. Pour fully into your belly the Soma essence, which is intoxicating and in the form of a wave. You are the lord of all the Somas pressed on former days.

English translation

Indra, attended by the Maruts, the showerer (of benefits), drink the Soma offered after the other presentations, for your exhilaration for battle ; take into your belly the (full) wave of the inebriating (Soma), for you are lord of libations from the days of old.

Special Topics

अनुष्पधं (*anuṣpadhaṃ*)—two words, अनु (*anu*) + स्वधा (*svadhā*), are joined: drinking of Soma after the offering of food in the form of svadhā. The scholar Monier Williams, giving the meaning of the word अनुष्पधं (*anuṣpadhaṃ*), says "According one's own will ; voluntary ;" that is, acting by one's own impulse without the prompting of others, and he refers to the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā; but nowhere in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā has Sāyaṇa given this meaning.

ऊर्मि (*ūrmi*)—ऊर्मिरूर्णोतेः (*ūrmirūrṇoteḥ*): it is the view of the Nirukta author that it is derived from the root ऊर्ण (*ūrṇa*), meaning to cover, conceal, envelop (Ni. 5-23). (The Uṇādi sūtra आर्तेरच्च (*ārtèracca*) is recited.) Just as it is used in the sense of wave (billow), the word is also used in the sense of mass of water, collection of water. Here it indicates the abundance of the Soma juice.

रणाय (*raṇāya*)—On the basis of the original meaning "delightful", the word रण (*raṇa*) is a synonym of battle. When the gods gather together and fight, there is a joyful cry that victory is assured; so (रणयंति (*raṇayaṃti*)) the word indicates that the battlefield too is delightful.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒जोषा॑ इन्द्र॒ सग॑णो म॒रुद्भि॒◌ः सोमं॑ पिब वृत्र॒हा
शू॑र वि॒द्वान् ।
ज॒हि शत्रूँ॒रप॒ मृधो॑ नुद॒स्वाथाभ॑यं कृणुहि वि॒श्वतो॑
नः ॥ २ ॥

> *sajoṣā indra sagaṇo marudbhiḥ somaṃ piba vṛtrahā śūra vidvān |*
> *jahi śatrū~rapa mṛdho nudasvāthābhayaṃ kṛṇuhi viśvato naḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सजोषाः । इंद्र । सगणः । मरुत्भिः । सोमं । पिब । वृत्रहा । शूर । विद्वान् ।
> जहि । शत्रून् । अप । मृधः । नुदस्व । अथ । अभयं । कृणुहि । विश्वतः । नः । ॥ २ ॥

> *sajoṣāḥ | iṃdra | sagaṇaḥ | marutbhiḥ | somaṃ | piba | vṛtrahā | śūra | vidvān |*
> *jahi | śatrūn | apa | mṛdhaḥ | nudasva | atha | abhayaṃ | kṛṇuhi | viśvataḥ | naḥ | ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सजोषा इंद्रेति मरुत्वतीयग्रहस्य याज्या । सूत्रितं च । सजोषा इंद्र
> सगणो मरुद्भिरिति भक्षयित्वैतत्पात्रं । आ. ५–१४ । इति ॥
> हे शूर बलवन् हे इंद्र सजोषाः संगतो देवैर्मरुद्भिः सगणो मरुद्भिरेव वृत्रहा वृत्रस्य हंता
> विद्वान्कर्मविषयाभिज्ञस्त्वं सोमं पिब । ततो नः

> *sajoṣā iṃdreti marutvatīyagrahasya yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | sajoṣā iṃdra sagaṇo marudbhiriti bhakṣayitvaitatpātraṃ | ā. 5-14 | iti ‖*
> *he śūra balavan he iṃdra sajoṣāḥ saṃgato devairmarudbhiḥ sagaṇo marudbhireva vṛtrahā vṛtrasya haṃtā vidvānkarmaviṣayābhijñastvaṃ somaṃ piba | tato naḥ*

> शत्रून् जहि । मृधो हिंसकान् शत्रूनप नुदस्व । यद्वा मृधः। हिंस्यंतेऽत्र प्राणिन
> इति मृधः संग्रामाः । तत्र वर्तमानान् शत्रूनसनुदस्व । अथानंतरं नोऽस्माकं
> विश्वतः सर्वतोऽभयं कृणुहि । कुरु । सर्वतो भयरहितानस्मान्कुर्वित्यर्थः ॥
> वृत्रहा । हंतेब्रह्मभ्रूणवृत्तेषु क्विप् । अभयं । इंभी भय इत्यस्मादेरच् ।
> नञा समासे तस्य स्वरः । विश्वतः । पंचम्यास्तसिल् । लित्स्वरः ॥

> *śatrūn jahi | mṛdho hiṃsakān śatrūnapa nudasva | yadvā mṛdhaḥ| hiṃsyaṃte 'tra prāṇina*
> *iti mṛdhaḥ saṃgrāmāḥ | tatra vartamānān śatrūnasanudasva | athānaṃtaraṃ no 'smākaṃ*
> *viśvataḥ sarvato 'bhayaṃ kṛṇuhi | kuru | sarvato bhayarahitānasmānkurvityarthaḥ ‖*
> *vṛtrahā | haṃtebrahmabhrūṇavṛtteṣu kvip | abhayaṃ | iṃbhī bhaya ityasmāderac |*
> *naññā samāse tasya svaraḥ | viśvataḥ | paṃcamyāstasil | litsvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

The verse सजोषा इंद्र (*sajoṣā iṃdra*) is the yājyā of the Marutvatīya graha. The sūtra says: सजोषा इंद्र सगणो मरुद्भिरिति भक्षयित्वैतत्पात्रं (*sajoṣā iṃdra sagaṇo marudbhiriti bhakṣayitvaitatpātraṃ*) (Ā. 5-14). "O mighty hero (शूर (*śūra*)) Indra, you who are united (सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*)) with the gods the Maruts, accompanied by your troop (सगणः (*sagaṇaḥ*)) by the Maruts alone, the slayer of Vṛtra, knowing (विद्वान् (*vidvān*)) the subject of the rites—drink the Soma. Then for us …" (the block breaks off here; the next window continues).

Sāyaṇa continues: "Slay the enemies. मृधः (*mṛdhaḥ*) are harmful enemies; drive them away." Or else मृधः (*mṛdhaḥ*) means battles, because living beings are injured in them ("they are harmed here"); drive away the enemies who stand in those battles. Then, afterwards, make us fearless on every side. The meaning is "make us free from fear everywhere."

Word-to-word meaning

- शूर (*śūra*)—valorous
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- मरुद्भिः (*marudbhiḥ*)—with the Maruts
- सगणः (*sagaṇaḥ*)—united (with them)
- सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*)—having equal affection (for them)
- वृत्रहा (*vṛtrahā*)—slayer of Vṛtra
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—wise; you who are such
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma juice
- पिब (*piba*)—drink
- शत्र्यन् (*śatryan*)—our enemies
- जहि (*jahi*)—defeat
- मृधः (*mṛdhaḥ*)—the enemies in battle
- आप नुदस्व (*āpa nudasva*)—destroy
- अथ (*atha*)—afterwards
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- विश्वतः (*viśvataḥ*)—from all sides
- अभयं (*abhayaṃ*)—freedom from fear
- कृणुहि (*kṛṇuhi*)—bring about

Gist

O valorous Indra, you who are united with the Maruts, who have equal affection for them, who are the slayer of Vṛtra and are wise, drink the Soma juice. Defeat our enemies. Destroy the enemies who are intent on battle, and afterwards make us free from fear on every side.

English translation

Indra, hero, rejoicing with and accompanied by the host of Maruts, drink the Soma, for you are the slayer of Vritra, the sage; subdue our ene- mies, drive away the malevolent, make us safe on every side from peril.

Special Topics

That this Ṛk beginning सजोषा इंद्र (*sajoṣā iṃdra*) is to be used as the yājyā mantra for the Marutvatīya graha is explained by the Āśvalāyana sūtra सजोषा इंद्र सगणो मरुद्भिरिति भक्षयेत्वैतत्पात्रं (*sajoṣā iṃdra sagaṇo marudbhiriti bhakṣayètvaitatpātraṃ*) (Ā. 5-14).

मृधः (*mṛdhaḥ*)—The word मृध (*mṛdha*) is read among the names of battle (Ni. 3-9). Its use is mostly in the sense of war. But in some contexts it is also understood as the enemy who is the cause of war. The Nirukta-kāra cites the Ṛk वि न इंद्र मृधो जहि नीचा यच्छ पृतन्यतः । (*vi na iṃdra mṛdho jahi nīcā yaccha pṛtanyataḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-152-5)

and shows that there it has the meaning "enemies who wage war" (Ni. 7-2). In the present Ṛk too the word stands as a synonym of "enemy".

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒त ऋ॒तुभि॑र्ऋतुपाः पाहि॒ सोम॒मिन्द्र॑ दे॒वेभि॒ः सखि॑
भिः सु॒तं न॑ः ।
याँ आभ॑जो म॒रुतो॒ ये त्वान्वह॑न्वृ॒त्रमद॑धु॒स्तुभ्य॒मो
ज॑ः ॥ ३ ॥

> *uta ṛtubhirṛtupāḥ pāhi somamindra devebhiḥ sakhibhiḥ sutaṃ naḥ |*
> *yā~ ābhajo maruto ye tvānvahanvṛtramadadhustubhyamojaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उत । ऋतुभिः । ऋतुपाः । पाहि । सोमं । इंद्र । देवेभिः । सखिभिः । सुतं ।
> नः ।
> यान् । आ । अभजः । मरुतः । ये । त्वा । अनु । अहन् । वृत्रं । अदधुः । तुभ्यं ।
> ओजः ॥ ३ ॥

> *uta | ṛtubhiḥ | ṛtupāḥ | pāhi | somaṃ | iṃdra | devebhiḥ | sakhibhiḥ |*
> *sutaṃ |*
> *naḥ |*
> *yān | ā | abhajaḥ | marutaḥ | ye | tvā | anu | ahan | vṛtraṃ | adadhuḥ*
> *| tubhyaṃ |*
> *ojaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उत अपि च हे ऋतुपाः कालनिर्वाहकतया ऋतूनां पातः । ऋतुषु
> सोमं पिबतीति वा ऋतुपाः । यद्वा ऋतुभिर्मरुद्भिः सह सोमं पिबतीति
> ऋतुपाः । तादृश हे इंद्र सखिभिः समानख्यानैर्यतुभिर्मरुद्भिर्देवेभिर्देवैः
> सहितस्त्वं नः संबंधिनं सुतमभिषुतं सोमं पाहि । पिब । किंच यान्मरुत आभजो
> युद्धसहायार्थमसेवथा ये च मरुतस्त्वा त्वां युद्धे स्वामिनमन्वभजंत ।
> ततस्त्वं वृत्रमहन् । हतवानसि । ते मरुतस्तुभ्यं त्वदर्थमोजो युद्धे शत्रुहननादिरूपं
> पराक्रममदधुः । अकुर्वन् ॥ अभजः । भज सेवायामित्यस्य लजि रूपं ।
> यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । अहन् । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य लजि सिपो हल्ङ्या दिना
> लोपः । पादादित्पादनिघातः । अदधुः । दधातेर्लजि झेः सिजभ्यस्तेति जुस् ।
> वाक्यभेदादनिघातः ॥

> *uta api ca he ṛtupāḥ kālanirvāhakatayā ṛtūnāṃ pātaḥ | ṛtuṣu*
> *somaṃ pibatīti vā ṛtupāḥ | yadvā ṛtubhirmarudbhiḥ saha somaṃ pibatīti*
> *ṛtupāḥ | tādṛśa he iṃdra sakhibhiḥ*
> *samānakhyānairyatubhirmarudbhirdevebhirdevaiḥ*
> *sahitastvaṃ naḥ saṃbaṃdhinaṃ sutamabhiṣutaṃ somaṃ pāhi | piba |*
> *kiṃca yānmaruta ābhajo*
> *yuddhasahāyārthamasevathā ye ca marutastvā tvāṃ yuddhe*
> *svāminamanvabhajaṃta |*
> *tatastvaṃ vṛtramahan | hatavānasi | te marutastubhyaṃ*
> *tvadarthamojo yuddhe śatruhananādirūpaṃ parākramamadadhuḥ |*
> *akurvan ‖ abhajaḥ | bhaja sevāyāmityasya laji rūpaṃ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | ahan | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya laji sipo*
> *halḍyā dinā*
> *lopaḥ | pādāditpādanighātaḥ | adadhuḥ | dadhāterlaji jheḥ sijabhyasteti*
> *jus |*
> *vākyabhedādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Moreover, O Ṛtupā": he who protects the seasons by regulating time; or he who drinks Soma in the seasons; or else he who drinks Soma together with the Ṛtus, that is, the Maruts. Such an Indra, being accompanied by his friends, the Maruts, who bear the same name as the Ṛtus, and by the gods, is to drink our pressed Soma. Further: the Maruts whom you resorted to for help in battle, and the Maruts who resorted to you as their lord in battle: thereupon you slew Vṛtra. Those Maruts placed in you ओजः (*ojaḥ*), vigour that takes the form of slaying enemies in battle; they produced it for you.

Word-to-word meaning

- उत (*uta*)—and
- ऋतुसाः (*ṛtusāḥ*)—one who drinks Soma together with the Maruts (or: one who drinks Soma at the fixed times)
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सखिभिः (*sakhibhiḥ*)—your friends
- ऋतुभिः (*ṛtubhiḥ*)—with the Maruts
- देवेभिः (*devebhiḥ*)—and with the gods; you who are united with them
- नः (*naḥ*)—by us
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- पाहि (*pāhi*)—drink
- यान् (*yān*)—which Maruts
- आभजः (*ābhajaḥ*)—you have served
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- अनु (*anu*)—served (and for that very reason)
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—Vṛtra
- अहन् (*ahan*)—you have slain (those same Maruts)
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—to you
- ओजः (*ojaḥ*)—the strength that destroys enemies
- आदधुः (*ādadhuḥ*)—produced

Gist

O Indra, who drink Soma according to the regulation of time, together with your friends the Maruts and with the gods, drink the Soma pressed by us. Because you served the Maruts, and because the Maruts served you, you became able to slay Vṛtra; those same Maruts produced in you the strength that destroys enemies.

English translation

Drinker of the Soma in season, drink with your divine friends the Maruts, the Soma that is presented by us; those Maruts whose aid you have enjoyed (in battle), and who, following you, have given you the strength whereby you have slain Vritra.

Special Topics

The words ऋतुपाः (*ṛtupāḥ*) and ऋतुभिः (*ṛtubhiḥ*) must be explained according to the context. For the word ऋतु (*ṛtu*) the meaning "fixed state" or "regulation of time" is current. From the offering of oblations duly, in accordance with such a fixed ṛtu-dharma, the word ऋत्विक् (*ṛtvik*) is formed. Or, according to some, the word ऋतु (*ṛtu*) means a vessel in which oblations are offered. As indicated in "को अग्निमाट्टे हविषा धृतेन सुचा यजाता ऋतुभिर्घ्रवेभिः (*ko agnimāṭṭe haviṣā dhṛtena sucā yajātā ṛtubhirghravebhiḥ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-84-18), सुक् (*suk*), ऋतु (*ṛtu*) and ध्रुव (*dhruva*) are all three vessels for offering oblations. In places such as इंद्र सोमं पिब ऋतुना (*iṃdra somaṃ piba ṛtunā*) (1-15-1) and मरुतः पिब ऋतुना (*marutaḥ piba ṛtunā*) (1-15-2), one view is that the word ऋतु (*ṛtu*) means a vessel. But Sāyaṇa has explained ऋतु (*ṛtu*) in these contexts as the deity Ṛtu, and the Saṃhitā too shows the meaning "deity". Even in the Ṛk 1-84-18 cited above Sāyaṇa has not taken it to mean a vessel; he has given it as the seasons beginning with spring.

If the word ऋतु (*ṛtu*) is a synonym of "deity", then ऋत्विक् (*ṛtvik*) means a worshipper of the deity. In the present Ṛk, ऋतुपाः (*ṛtupāḥ*) can be explained as the Indra who drinks Soma in the seasons, and ऋतुभिः (*ṛtubhiḥ*) as the Indra who is united with the deities named Ṛtu. Sāyaṇa has explained them as the Marut deities. When one says ऋतुभिः देवेभिः (*ṛtubhiḥ devebhiḥ*), if ऋतुभिः (*ṛtubhiḥ*) is made an adjective of देवेभिः (*devebhiḥ*), it can also mean "with the deities named Ṛtu".

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ये त्वा॑हि॒हत्ये॑ मघव॒न्नव॑र्ध॒न्ये शा॑म्ब॒रे ह॑रिवो॒ ये गवि॑ष्टौ ।
ये त्वा॑ नू॒नम॑नु॒मद॑न्ति॒ विप्रा॒ः पिबे॑न्द्र॒ सोमं॒ सग॑णो म॒रुद्भि॑ः ॥ ४ ॥

> *ye tvāhihatye maghavannavardhanye śāmbare harivo ye gaviṣṭau |*
> *ye tvā nūnamanumadanti viprāḥ pibendra somaṃ sagaṇo marudbhiḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ये । त्वा । अहिहत्ये । मघवन् । अवर्धन् । ये । शांबरे । हरवः । ये ।
> गोऽइष्टौ ।
> ये । त्वा । नूनं । अनुमदंति । विप्राः । पिब । इंद्र । सोमं । सगणः ।
> मरुत्भिः ॥ ४ ।

> *ye | tvā | ahihatye | maghavan | avardhan | ye | śāṃbare | haravaḥ | ye |*
> *go 'iṣṭau |*
> *ye | tvā | nūnaṃ | anumadaṃti | viprāḥ | piba | iṃdra | somaṃ | sagaṇaḥ |*
> *marutbhiḥ ‖ 4 |*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मरुत्वतीयशस्त्रे याज्या ये त्वाहिहत्य इत्येषा । सूत्रितं च । ये त्वाहिहत्ये मघवन्नवर्धन्निति याज्या । आ. ५–१४ । इति ॥
> हे मघवन्निंद्र ये मरुतोऽहिहत्ये वृत्रहननरूपे कर्मणि त्वा त्वामवर्धन् प्रहर भगवो जहि वीरयस्वेति बलदानेनावीवृधन् । हे हरिवोऽश्ववन्निंद्र
> ये च शांबरे शंबरवधसंबंधिनि युद्धे त्वामवीवृधन् । इंद्रः शंबरमवधीदित्यस्मिन्नर्थे मंत्रवर्णः । यः शंबरं पर्वतेषु क्षियंतं चत्वारिंश्यां शरद्यन्वविंदत् । ओजायमानं यो अहिं जघान । ऋग्वे २–१२–११ । इति । तथा ये
> मरुतो गविष्टौ पणिनामकैरसुरैः सह गवार्थे युद्धे च त्वामवीवृधन् । विप्रा

> *marutvatīyaśastre yājyā ye tvāhihatya ityeṣā | sūtritaṃ ca | ye tvāhihatye maghavannavardhanniti yājyā | ā. 5-14 | iti ‖*
> *he maghavanniṃdra ye maruto 'hihatye vṛtrahananarūpe karmaṇi tvā tvāmavardhan prahara bhagavo jahi vīrayasveti baladānenāvīvṛdhan | he harivo 'śvavanniṃdra*
> *ye ca śāṃbare śaṃbaravadhasaṃbaṃdhini yuddhe tvāmavīvṛdhan | iṃdraḥ śaṃbaramavadhīdityasminnarthe maṃtravarṇaḥ | yaḥ śaṃbaraṃ parvateṣu kṣiyaṃtaṃ catvāriṃśyāṃ śaradyanvaviṃdat | ojāyamānaṃ yo ahiṃ jaghāna | ṛgve 2-12-11 | iti | tathā ye*
> *maruto gaviṣṭau paṇināmakairasuraiḥ saha gavārthe yuddhe ca tvāmavīvṛdhan | viprā*

> मेधाविनो ये च मरुतो नूनमिदानीं त्वामनुमदंति मादयंति तादृशैस्त्यर्मरुद्भिः सगणः सन् इमं सोमं पिब ॥ अहिहत्ये । हंतेर्भावे हनस्त चेति क्यप् ।
> कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । अवर्धन् । वृधु वृद्धावित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लजि रूपं । छंदस्युभयथेति
> झीरार्धधातुकत्वाणेर्लोपः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । शांबरे । शंबरस्येदमित्यर्थे
> तस्येदमित्यण्प्रत्ययः । गविष्टौ । इषु इच्छायां । भावे क्तिन् । बहुव्रीहौ
> पूर्वपदस्वरः । अनुमदंति । मदि स्तुत्यादिश्वित्यस्य लटि व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं ।
> आगमानुशासनस्यानित्यत्वान्नुमभावः । झीर्लसार्वधातुकस्वरे कृते धातुस्वरः । तिजं
> चोदात्तवतीति गतेर्निघातः ॥

> *medhāvino ye ca maruto nūnamidānīṃ tvāmanumadaṃti mādayaṃti tādṛśaistyarmaruddhiḥ sagaṇaḥ san imaṃ somaṃ piba ‖ ahihatye | haṃterbhāve hanasta ceti kyap |*
> *kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | avardhan | vṛdhu vṛddhāvityasya ṇyaṃtasya laji rūpaṃ | chaṃdasyubhayatheti*
> *jhīrārdhadhātukatvāṇerlopaḥ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | śāṃbare |*

> *śaṃbarasyedamityarthe tasyedamityaṇpratyayaḥ | gaviṣṭau | iṣu icchāyāṃ | bhāve ktin | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | anumadaṃti | madi stutyādiśvityasya laṭi vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ | āgamānuśāsanasyānityatvānnumabhāvaḥ | jhīrlasārvadhātukasvare kṛte dhātusvaraḥ | tijaṃ codāttavatīti gaternighātaḥ ||*

Summary

The Ṛk ये त्वाहिहत्ये (*ye tvāhihatye*) is the yājyā in the Marutvatīya śastra. It is prescribed by the sūtra ये त्वाहिहत्ये मघवन्नवर्धन्निति याज्या (*ye tvāhihatye maghavannavardhanniti yājyā*) (Ā. 5-14). O Maghavan Indra, the Maruts who in the work of slaying Ahi (Vṛtra) strengthened you by giving you strength, with words such as "strike, blessed one, slay, show your valour"; and, O Harivān (possessor of horses) Indra, those who strengthened you in the battle connected with the slaying of Śambara. That Indra slew Śambara is stated by a mantra passage: यः शंबरं पर्वतेषु क्षियंतं चत्वारिंश्यां शरद्यन्वविंदत् । ओजायमानं यो अहिं जघान । (*yaḥ śaṃbaraṃ parvateṣu kṣiyaṃtaṃ catvāriṃśyāṃ śaradyanvaviṃdat | ojāyamānaṃ yo ahiṃ jaghāna |*) (Ṛgve. 2-12-11)[?] [39]. Likewise the Maruts who strengthened you in the battle for cattle, गविष्टौ (*gaviṣṭau*), against the asuras named Paṇis; and the wise

Maruts who now delight you: together with such Maruts, in company, drink this Soma.

The Gist for the portion of this block that stands in this window is given in the preceding paragraph, which completes the sentence ("the wise Maruts who now delight you … drink this Soma"); the remainder of the block is grammatical.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—wealthy one
- हरिवः (*harivaḥ*)—possessor of horses
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts

- अहिहत्ये (*ahihatye*)—in the work consisting of the slaying of Vṛtra
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- अवर्धन् (*avardhan*)—made to grow
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts
- शांबरे (*śāṃbare*)—in the battle fought with Śambara, gave strength
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts
- गविष्टौ (*gaviṣṭau*)—helped in the recovery of the stolen cattle (and)
- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—wise
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts
- नूनं (*nūnaṃ*)—now
- अनुमदंति (*anumadaṃti*)—are gratifying to you
- मरुद्भिः (*marudbhiḥ*)—with (such) Maruts
- सगणः (*sagaṇaḥ*)—united together
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—this Soma
- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, wealthy and possessed of horses, the Maruts who strengthened you in the work of slaying Vṛtra, who gave you strength in the battle fought with Śambara, who helped you in the recovery of the stolen cattle, and who, being wise, are now gratifying to you: united with such Maruts, drink this Soma.

English translation

They who encouraged you Maghavan, to slay Ahi, who (aided you) in the conflict with Shambara, and in the recovery of the cattle, and who, possessed of wisdom, contribute verily to your exhilaration, with them, the troop of the Maruts, Indra, drink the Soma.

Special Topics

That this Ṛk beginning ये त्वाहिहत्ये (*ye tvāhihatye*) is to be recited as the yājyā mantra at the time of reciting the Marutvatīya śastra is explained by the sūkta[?40] of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra, ये त्वाहिहत्ये मघवन्नवर्धन्निति याज्या (*ye tvāhihatye maghavannavardhanniti yājyā*) (Ā. 5-14).

The friendship between Indra and the Maruts, and the nature of the help that the Maruts gave Indra in many situations, have been explained fully before. Of these, three situations are indicated here.

The name of Śambara is usually joined with the asuras Śuṣṇa, Pipru and Varcin. In some Ṛks he is called a dāsa (6-26-5). It is said that for King Divodāsa, a close friend of Indra, Indra overthrew all the countless forts of the enemy Śambara and gave Divodāsa his property. These matters too have been told before. It is also said that this asura hid himself in the hills and mountains and caused great harm to Atithigva and Divodāsa, and so Indra destroyed him and gave both of them his protection. Like Ahi and Vṛtra, Śambara too can be said to be a person who represents a dense darkness.

"Sambara, meaning among other things the cloud, seems to be some mythical beings connected with the powers of darkness". Oldenberg.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒रुत्व॑न्तं वृष॒भं वा॑वृधा॒नमक॑वारिं दि॒व्यं शा॒समिन्द्र॑म् ।
वि॒श्वा॒साह॒मव॑से॒ नूत॑नायो॒ग्रं स॑हो॒दामि॒ह तं हु॑वेम ॥ ५ ॥

> *marutvantaṃ vṛṣabhaṃ vāvṛdhānamakavāriṃ divyaṃ śāsamindram |*
> *viśvāsāhamavase nūtanāyograṃ sahodāmiha taṃ huvema ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मरुत्वंतं । वृषभं । ववृधानं । अकवअरिं । दिव्यं । शासं । इंद्रं ।
> विश्वसहं । अवसे । नूतनाय । उग्रं । सहःदां । इह । तं । हुवेम ॥ ५ ॥

> *marutvaṃtaṃ | vṛṣabhaṃ | vavṛdhānaṃ | akavaariṃ | divyaṃ | śāsaṃ | iṃdraṃ |*
> *viśvasahaṃ | avase | nūtanāya | ugraṃ | sahaḥdāṃ | iha | taṃ | huvema ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र मरुत्वंतं मरुद्भिस्तद्वंतं वृषभं मेघभेदनद्वारापां वर्षक
> ववृधानं वृत्रहननादिकर्मसूत्साहेन वर्धमानमकवारिं प्रभूतशत्रु कं यद्वा

> *he iṃdra marutvaṃtaṃ marudbhistadvaṃtaṃ vṛṣabhaṃ meghabhedanadvārāpāṃṃ varṣaka*
> *vavṛdhānaṃ vṛtrahananādikarmasūtsāhena vardhamānamakavāriṃ prabhūtaśatru kaṃ yadvā*

> अकुत्सि तारिं । तथा च मंत्रः । स्वरिरमत्तो ववक्षे रणाय । ऋग्वे. १–६१–९ । इति ।
> दिव्यं दिवि स्वर्गलोके वर्तमानं शासं हितोपदेशाहितपरिहाराभ्यां शासितारं
> विश्वासाहं विश्वस्य प्रतिपक्षस्य सर्वस्याभिभवितारमुग्रं शत्रुषूद्रूर्णं सहोदां
> युद्धसहकारिणां मरुतां बलप्रदं तं तादृशसामर्थ्यपेतमिंद्रं नूतनाय
> नवतरायावसे रक्षणायेह कर्मणि हुवेम । त्वामाह्वयेम ॥ नूतनाय ।
> नवतरायावतसे रक्षणायेह कर्मणि हुवेम । त्वामाह्वयेम ॥ नूतनाय ।
> नवशब्दस्य नू इत्यादेशः । त्वप्तनखःश्च प्रत्यया वक्तव्या इति तनप्रत्ययः ॥

> *akutsi tāriṃ | tathā ca maṃtraḥ | svariramatto vavakṣe raṇāya | ṛgve. 1-61-9 | iti |*
> *divyaṃ divi svargaloke vartamānaṃ śāsaṃ hitopadeśāhitaparihārābhyāṃ śāsitāraṃ*
> *viśvāsāhaṃ viśvasya pratipakṣasya sarvasyābhibhavitāramugraṃ śatruṣūdrūrṇaṃ sahodāṃ*
> *yuddhasahakāriṇāṃ marutāṃ balapradaṃ taṃ tādṛśasāmarthyapetamiṃdraṃ nūtanāya*
> *navatarāyāvase rakṣaṇāyeha karmaṇi huvema | tvāmāhvayema ‖ nūtanāya |*
> *navatarāyāvatase rakṣaṇāyeha karmaṇi huvema | tvāmāhvayema ‖*

> *nūtanāya* |
> *navaśabdasya nū ityādeśaḥ* | *tvaptanakhaḥśca pratyayā vaktavyā iti tanapratyayaḥ* ||

Summary

"O Indra, मरुत्वंतं (*marutvaṃtaṃ*)", accompanied by the Maruts; वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*), the rainer of waters by splitting the cloud; ववृधानं (*vavṛdhānaṃ*), growing through zeal in works such as the slaying of Vṛtra; akavāri, one who has many enemies[?41]; "or else" — the block breaks off here and the next window continues it.

The block opens by completing the explanation of अकवारिं (*akavāriṃ*) begun on the previous page.[?42] A mantra is cited in support: स्वरिरमत्तो ववक्षे रणाय (*svariramatto vavakṣe raṇāya*) (Ṛgve. 1-61-9).[?43] Then he glosses the remaining words. दिव्यं (*divyaṃ*): dwelling in heaven. शासं (*śāsaṃ*): the ruler who governs by beneficial instruction and by warding off harm. विश्वासाहं (*viśvāsāhaṃ*): the overcomer of every adversary. उग्रं (*ugraṃ*): formidable against enemies. सहोदां (*sahodāṃ*): the giver of strength to the Maruts, his allies in battle. Indra, so endowed, we call to this rite for new, that is, fresher protection (नूतनाय (*nūtanāya*), अवसे (*avase*), हुवेम (*huvema*): "we invoke you"). The rest of the block is grammar on नूतनाय (*nūtanāya*).

Word-to-word meaning

- मरुत्वंतं (*marutvaṃtaṃ*)—one accompanied by the Maruts
- वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—one who sends down rain
- ववृधानं (*vavṛdhānaṃ*)—one who grows (with zeal)
- अकवारिं (*akavāriṃ*)—one who has abundant enemies
- दिव्यं (*divyaṃ*)—one who dwells in the world of the gods
- शासं (*śāsaṃ*)—the instructor
- विश्वासाहं (*viśvāsāhaṃ*)—one who defeats all enemies
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—the terrible one
- सहोदां (*sahodāṃ*)—the giver of strength to the Maruts, his companions
- तं इंद्रं (*taṃ iṃdraṃ*)—that Indra
- नूतनाय (*nūtanāya*)—new

- अवसे (*avase*)—for protection
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrificial rite
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—we call with prayer

Gist

Indra, who is accompanied by the Maruts, sends down rain, grows with zeal, has abundant enemies, dwells in the world of the gods, is the instructor, defeats all enemies, is terrible, and gives strength to his companions the Maruts: him we call with prayer in this sacrificial rite for fresh protection.

English translation

We inovke to this sacrifice for present protection Indra, the chief of the Maruts, the showerer (of benefits) ; augmenting (in glory), overcoming many foes, divine regulator (of good and ill), the subduer of all (enemies), the fierce the bestower of strength.

Special Topics

Akavārim: this word has been explained as "one with abundant enemies". The word kava is formed from the root ku, which gives the sense "contemptible"; kava therefore means what is small, despised, blameworthy. From this root both forms, kava and kavāri, are formed.

The word kuvāri[?44] in general means a man who is extremely selfish, miserly, performs no sacrifice and leads a contemptible life. In the present ṛk, where akavārim stands, the word kava means a small, despised person, and the compound is kava-ari: a petty enemy. One who is not a kavāri is an akavāri, that is, an enemy of great power; or an abundant number may also be indicated by it. It is an epithet showing Indra's greatness: one who can face such enemies.

Sūkta 48 (Maṇḍala 3)

> सद्यो हेति पंचर्चं दशमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभमैंद्रं । सद्यो
> हेत्यनुक्रमणिका । अग्निष्टोमे माध्यंदिनसवने मैत्रावरुणशस्त्रे सद्यो ह जात
> इत्येतत्तूक्तं । सूत्रितं च । सद्योह जात एवा त्वामिंद्र । आ. ५. १६ । इति ॥
> चातुर्विंशिकेऽप्यहनि मैत्रावरुणशस्त्रेऽहरहः शस्यसंज्ञमेतत्तूक्तं॥ सूत्रितं च ।
> सद्यो ह जात इत्यहरहःशस्यं मैत्रावरुणः । आ. ७ ४ । इति ॥ अहर्गणे द्वितीयादिष्वहःसु
> माध्यंदिनसवनेऽस्मिन् शस्त्र एतत्तूक्तं । अहरहः शस्यानीति होत्रका
> द्वितीयादिष्टेव । आ. ७. १ । इति सूत्रितं ॥ साद्यस्क्र एकाहे मरुत्वतीये शस्त्रे
> सद्यो ह जात इत्याद्या सूक्तमुखीया । सूत्रितं च । सद्यो ह जातो वृषभः
> कनीनस्त्वं सद्यो अपिबो जात इंद्र । आ. ९. ५ । इति ॥

> *sadyo heti paṃcarcaṃ daśamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ*
> *traiṣṭubhamaiṃdraṃ | sadyo*
> *hetyanukramaṇikā | agniṣṭome mādhyaṃdinasavane*
> *maitrāvaruṇaśastre sadyo ha jāta*
> *ityetattūktaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | sadyoha jāta evā tvāmiṃdra | ā. 5. 16 | iti*
> *‖*
> *cāturviṃśike 'pyahani maitrāvaruṇaśastre 'harahaḥ*
> *śasyasaṃjñametattūktaṃ‖ sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *sadyo ha jāta ityaharahaḥśasyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ | ā. 7 4 | iti ‖ ahargaṇe*
> *dvitīyādiṣvahaḥsu mādhyaṃdinasavane 'smin śastra etattūktaṃ |*
> *aharahaḥ śasyānīti hotrakā*
> *dvitīyādiṣṭeva | ā. 7. 1 | iti sūtritaṃ ‖ sādyaskra ekāhe marutvatīye*
> *śastre*
> *sadyo ha jāta ityādyā sūktamukhīyā | sūtritaṃ ca | sadyo ha jāto*
> *vṛṣabhaḥ*
> *kanīnastvaṃ sadyo apibo jāta iṃdra | ā. 9. 5 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

This is the tenth sūkta of the fourth anuvāka, सद्यो ह (*sadyo ha*), of five ṛks; the seer is Viśvāmitra, the deity Indra, the metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā begins सद्यो ह (*sadyo ha*). Uses: in the Agniṣṭoma, at the midday pressing, this sūkta (सद्यो ह जात (*sadyo ha jāta*)) belongs to the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra, and the sūtra says सद्यो ह जात एवा त्वामिंद्र (*sadyo ha jāta evā tvāmiṃdra*) (Ā. Sū. 5.16).[?45] On the Cāturviṃśika day, in the

Maitrāvaruṇa śastra, this sūkta is the one called ahar-ahaḥ-śasya; the sūtra says सद्यो ह जात इत्यहरहःशस्यं मैत्रावरुणः (*sadyo ha jāta ityaharahaḥśasyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ*) (Ā. Sū. 7.4). In an ahargaṇa, from the second day onward, at the midday pressing, it is used in this śastra; the sūtra: अहरहः शस्यानीति होत्रका द्वितीयादिष्टेव (*aharahaḥ śasyānīti hotrakā dvitīyādiṣṭeva*) (Ā. Sū. 7.1). In the one-day sādyaskra rite, in the Marutvatīya śastra, its first ṛk सद्यो ह जात (*sadyo ha jāta*) is the sūktamukhīya (opening verse); the sūtra: सद्यो ह जातो वृषभः कनीनस्त्वं सद्यो अपिबो जात इंद्र । (*sadyo ha jāto vṛṣabhaḥ kanīnastvaṃ sadyo apibo jāta iṃdra* |) (Ā. Sū. 9.5).

Anuvāda (Kannada): This sūkta सद्यो ह (*sadyo ha*) is the tenth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka and has five ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, deity Indra, metre Triṣṭubh. It is stated in the Anukramaṇikā as beginning with सद्यो ह (*sadyo ha*). Its use for the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra mantras at the midday pressing of the Agniṣṭoma sacrifice is set out by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra सद्यो ह जात एवा त्वामिंद्र (*sadyo ha jāta evā tvāmiṃdra*) (Ā. 5-6). Its use for the recitation called ahar-ahaḥ-śastra, when the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra mantras are recited on the twenty-fourth (Cāturviṃśaka) day, is set out by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra सद्यो ह जात इत्यहरहः शस्यं मैत्रावरुणः (*sadyo ha jāta ityaharahaḥ śasyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ*) (Ā. 7-4). Its use for reciting the śastra mantras at the midday pressing, from the second day onward of the sacrifice called ahargaṇa, is set out by the sūtra अहरहः शस्यानीति होत्रका द्वितीयादिष्टेव (*aharahaḥ śasyānīti hotrakā dvitīyādiṣṭeva*)

(Ā. 7-1). Its use for the first ṛk of this sūkta, in reciting the Marutvatīya śastra mantras in the one-day sacrifice called sādyaskra, is set out by the sūtra सद्यो ह जातो वृषभ, कनीनस्त्वं सद्यो अपिबो जात इंद्र (*sadyo ha jāto vṛṣabha, kanīnastvaṃ sadyo apibo jāta iṃdra*) (Ā. 9-5).

Om.

Sūkta 48.

Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 48.

Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Varga 12.

Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 5.

Ṛṣi: Viśvāmitra.

Devatā: Indra.

Chandas: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒द्यो ह॑ जा॒तो वृ॑ष॒भः क॒नीन॒ः प्रभ॑र्तुमाव॒दन्ध॑सः
सु॒तस्य॑ ।
सा॒धोः पि॑ब प्रतिका॒मं यथा॑ ते॒ रसा॑शिरः प्रथ॒मं
सो॒म्यस्य॑ ॥ १ ॥

> *sadyo ha jāto vṛṣabhaḥ kanīnaḥ prabhartumāvadandhasaḥ sutasya |*
> *sādhoḥ piba pratikāmaṃ yathā te rasāśiraḥ prathamaṃ somyasya ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सद्यः । ह । जातः । वृषभः । कनीनः। प्रभर्तुं । आवत् । अंधसः । सुतस्य ।
> साधोः । पिब । प्रतिकामं । यथा । ते । रसआशिरः । प.थमं । सोम्यस्य ॥ १ ॥

> *sadyaḥ | ha | jātaḥ | vṛṣabhaḥ | kanīnaḥ| prabhartuṃ | āvat |*
> *aṃdhasaḥ | sutasya |*
> *sādhoḥ | piba | pratikāmaṃ | yathā | te | rasaāśiraḥ | pa.thamaṃ |*
> *somyasya ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषभो वृष्टिद्वारापां वर्षिता सद्यस्तदानीमेव जात उत्पन्नः कनीनः
> कमनीय इंद्रः सुतस्याभिषुतस्यांधसो हविर्लक्षणस्यान्नस्य सोमस्य प्रभर्तुं

> *vṛṣabho vṛṣṭidvārāpāṃ varṣitā sadyastadānīmeva jāta utpannaḥ kanīnaḥ*
> *kamanīya iṃdraḥ sutasyābhiṣutasyāṃdhaso havirlakṣaṇasyānnasya*
> *somasya prabhartuṃ*

> प्रकर्षण भर्तारं संग्रहीतारं यजमानमावत् । रक्षतु । ह प्रसिद्धौ । किंच तादृशस्त्वं प्रतिकामं
> कामे कामे सोमपानेच्छायां सत्यां ते तव यथा कामस्य
> पूर्तिर्भवति तथा साधो रसात्मना संसिद्धं रसाशिरो गोपयोमिश्रणोपेतं
> सोम्यस्य सोममयं रसं प्रथमं सर्वेभ्यो देवेभ्यः पुरस्तात्पिब ॥ प्रतिकामं ।
> कामं कामं प्रति । वीप्सायामव्ययाभावः । समासस्वरः । यथा । अपादांतत्वादेव
> लित्स्वरः । रसाशिरः । आज्पूर्वात् श्रीणातेः क्विप्यपस्पृधेथामित्यादिनाशिर् इत्यादेशः।
> बहुप्रीहौ पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । सोम्यस्य । सोमशब्दान्मयडर्थे मये चेति
> यप्रत्ययः ॥

> *prakarṣaṇa bhartāraṃ saṃgrahītāraṃ yajamānamāvat | rakṣatu | ha prasiddhau | kiṃca tādṛśastvaṃ pratikāmaṃ kāme kāme*
> *somapānecchāyāṃ satyāṃ te tava yathā kāmasya*
> *pūrtirbhavati tathā sādho rasātmanā saṃsiddhaṃ rasāśiro gòpayomiśraṇopetaṃ*
> *somyasya somamayaṃ rasaṃ prathamaṃ sarvebhyo devebhyaḥ purastātpiba ‖ pratikāmaṃ |*
> *kāmaṃ kāmaṃ prati | vīpsāyāmavyayābhāvaḥ | samāsasvaraḥ | yathā | apādāṃtatvādeva*
> *litsvaraḥ | rasāśiraḥ | ājpūrvāt śrīṇāteḥ kvipyapaspṛdhethāmityādināśir ityādeśaḥ|*
> *bahuprīhau pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | somyasya |*
> *somaśabdānmayaḍarthe maye ceti*
> *yapratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*): he who rains down through the clouds' bursting; सद्यः (*sadyaḥ*): at that very moment; जातः (*jātaḥ*): born; कनीनः (*kanīnaḥ*): the desirable Indra. सुतस्य (*sutasya*): of the pressed अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*), the food in the form of oblation, Soma; प्रभर्तुं (*prabhartuṃ*) (the block breaks off here and continues on the next page).

प्रभर्तुं (*prabhartuṃ*): the bearer, the gatherer in abundance, the sacrificer; may Indra protect him (आवत् (*āvat*)). ह (*ha*) (both) are well-known particles. Further, O Indra, being such, whenever the desire to drink Soma arises (प्रतिकामं (*pratikāmaṃ*)), as your desire may be fulfilled, drink first, before all the gods, the Soma juice (सोम्यस्य (*somyasya*), made of Soma), perfected as juice (साधोः (*sādhoḥ*)) and

रसाशिरः (*rasāśiraḥ*), that is, mixed with cow's milk. The rest is grammar on प्रतिकामं (*pratikāmaṃ*), यथा (*yathā*), रसाशिरः (*rasāśiraḥ*) and सोम्यस्य (*somyasya*).

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—the sender-down of rain
- सद्यो ह जातः (*sadyo ha jātaḥ*)—as soon as born
- कनीनः (*kanīnaḥ*)—Indra, who has an attractive form
- सुतस्य (*sutasya*)—pressed
- अंधसः (*aṃdhasaḥ*)—the food in the form of Soma
- प्रभर्तुं (*prabhartuṃ*)—the sacrificer who holds it in abundance
- आवत् (*āvat*)—may he protect (O Indra)
- प्रतिकामं (*pratikāmaṃ*)—whenever you have the wish
- ते (*te*)—to you
- यथा (*yathā*)—so as to be satisfied
- साधोः (*sādhoḥ*)—juicy
- रसाशिरः (*rasāśiraḥ*)—mixed with milk
- सोम्यस्य (*somyasya*)—Soma juice
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—before all the gods
- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

May Indra, the sender-down of rain, who is of a charming form as soon as he is born, protect the sacrificer who devoutly holds the pressed Soma. O Indra, whenever you wish, drink, so as to be satisfied, the juicy, milk-mixed Soma juice before all the gods.

English translation

May the showerer (of rain), who, as soon as born, is the object of affection, protect the offerer of the effused libation: drink at will, Indra, before (the other gods), of the pure Soma juice mixed with milk.

Special Topics

प्रतिकामं यथा ते (*pratikāmaṃ yathā te*)—कामे कामे सोमपानेच्छायां सत्यां ते तव यथा कामस्य पूर्तिर्भवति तथा (पिब) (*kāme kāme somapānecchāyāṃ satyāṃ te tava yathā kāmasya pūrtirbhavati tathā (piba)*). O Indra, whenever the wish to drink Soma arises in you, that is, whenever you like, drink Soma juice as much as will satisfy you: so the seer prays.

रसाशिरः (*rasāśiraḥ*)—rasa here means liquid milk. The meaning is Soma juice mixed with such milk, or gavāśira.

प्रथमं सोम्यस्य (*prathamaṃ somyasya*)—सोममयं रसं प्रथमं सर्वेभ्यो देवेभ्यः पुरस्तात्पिब (*somamayaṃ rasaṃ prathamaṃ sarvebhyo devebhyaḥ purastātpiba*). The meaning: drink the Soma, strained and prepared as juice, before the other gods drink it, that is, you first of all.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यज्जाय॑था॒स्तदह॑रस्य॒ कामे॒ंऽशोः पी॒यूष॑मपिबो गिरि॒ष्ठाम् ।
तं ते॑ मा॒ता परि॒ योषा॒ जनि॑त्री म॒हः पि॒तुर्दम॒ आ सि॑ञ्च॒दग्रे॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *yajjāyathāstadaharasya kāmeṃ 'śoḥ pīyūṣamapibo giriṣṭhām |*
> *taṃ te mātā pari yoṣā janitrī mahaḥ piturdama āsiñcadagre ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यत् । जायथाः । तत् । अनः । अस्य । कामे । अंशोः । पीयूषं । अपिबः ।
> गिरिष्ठां ।
> तं । ते । माता । परि । योषा । जनित्री । महः । पितुः । दमे । आ । असिंचत् ।
> अग्रे ॥ २ ॥

> *yat | jāyathāḥ | tat | anaḥ | asya | kāme | aṃśoḥ | pīyūṣam | apibaḥ |*
> *giriṣṭhām |*
> *taṃ | te | mātā | pari | yoṣā | janitrī | mahaḥ | pituḥ | dame | ā |*
> *asiṃcat |*
> *agre ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं यद्यस्मिन्नहनि जायथा अजायथाः तदहस्तस्मिन्नेवाहन्यस्य
> सोमस्य कामे पिसासायां सत्यां गिरिष्ठां गिरिस्थां पर्वतोस्कोच्चस्थाने वर्तमानमंशोः
> सोमलताखंडविशिष्टस्य ऋजीषस्य पीयूषमभिनवं रसमपिबः । पीतवानसि । उत्पत्तिक्षण एव
> सोमपाने कारणं दर्शयति । ते तव जनित्री माता योषा
> युवतिरदितिर्महो महतः पितुर्जनकस्य कश्यपस्य दमे सूतिकागृहेऽग्रे स्तन्यदानात् प्राक् तं
> तादृषं सोमं पर्यासिंचत् । तवास्ये̀ परितोऽक्षारयत् ॥

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ yadyasminnahani jāyathā ajāyathāḥ*
> *tadahastasminnevāhanyasya*
> *somasya kāme pisāsāyāṃ satyāṃ giriṣṭhāṃ giristhāṃ*
> *parvatoskoccasthāne vartamānamaṃśoḥ somalatākhaṃḍaviśiṣṭasya*
> *ṛjīṣasya pīyūṣamabhinavaṃ rasamapibaḥ | pītavānasi | utpattikṣaṇa eva*
> *somapāne kāraṇaṃ darśayati | te tava janitrī mātā yoṣā*
> *yuvatiraditirmaho mahataḥ piturjanakasya kaśyapasya dame sūtikāgṛhe*
> *'gre stanyadānāt prāk taṃ tādṛṣaṃ somaṃ paryāsiṃcat | tavāsyè parito*
> *'kṣārayat ‖*

> जायथाः । जनी प्रादुर्भाव इत्यस्य लजि बहुलं छंदसीत्यडभावः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ।
> जनित्री । जनिता मंत्र इति निपातनाण्णेर्लोपः ॥

> *jāyathāḥ | janī prādurbhāva ityasya laji bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyaḍabhāvaḥ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | janitrī | janitā maṃtra iti nipātanāṇṇerlopaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, on the day on which you were born, on that very day, when the desire for this Soma arose, you drank the nectar, the fresh juice, of the अंशोः (*aṃśoḥ*), which is distinguished by pieces of the Soma plant, of the ṛjīṣa, गिरिष्ठां (*giriṣṭhāṃ*) (गिरिस्थां (*giristhāṃ*)), standing on the high place of a mountain.[?46] He shows the reason for drinking Soma at the very moment of birth: your mother (जनित्री (*janitrī*)), the young woman (योषा (*yoṣā*)) Aditi, in the lying-in chamber of your great father, your begetter Kaśyapa (महः पितुः दमे (*mahaḥ pituḥ dame*)), before giving the breast (अग्रे (*agre*)), poured that Soma around you (पर्यासिंचत् (*paryāsiṃcat*)), that is, made it flow all around your mouth.

The block contains only grammatical notes, on जायथाः (*jāyathāḥ*) and जनित्री (*janitrī*).

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) यत् (*yat*)—when
- जायथाः (*jāyathāḥ*)—you were born
- तदहः (*tadahaḥ*)—that very day
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Soma juice
- कामे (*kāme*)—when the desire to drink arose
- गिरिष्ठां (*giriṣṭhāṃ*)—that was at the high place of the mountain
- अंशोः (*aṃśoḥ*)—of the piece of Soma plant
- पीयूषं (*pīyūṣaṃ*)—the juice
- आपिबः (*āpibaḥ*)—you drank
- ते (*te*)—your
- जनित्री (*janitrī*)—mother
- योषा (*yoṣā*)—and young woman, Aditi
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—great-souled
- पितुः (*pituḥ*)—your father, Kaśyapa's
- दमे (*dame*)—in the lying-in chamber
- अग्रे (*agre*)—before (giving you) the breast
- तं (*taṃ*)—that Soma
- परि आसिंचत् (*pari āsiṃcat*)—she made you drink fully

Gist

O Indra, as soon as you were born, when the desire to drink Soma juice arose, you drank the juice of the piece of Soma plant that was at the high place of the mountain. Your mother, the young Aditi, in the lying-in chamber of the great-souled Kaśyapa, your begetter, made you drink that Soma fully before giving you the breast.

English translation

On the day on which you were born, you drank at will the mountain-abiding nectar of this Soma plant. for your youthful parent mother (Aditi), in the dwelling of your great sire (Kashyapa), gave it to you before she gave the breast.

Special Topics

The first half of this ṛk explains that Indra felt the wish to drink Soma on the very day he was born and drank that nectar-like Soma juice. The second half describes how Indra's mother, a young woman, in her husband's house, as soon as Indra was born, made him drink Soma juice before nursing him at the breast. This indicates that Indra's desire to drink Soma has been great from the beginning. Here, although there is no statement of who Indra's mother is or who his father is, the commentator says that the mother of Indra is Aditi, the mother of the gods, and the father is Kaśyapa. Although this explanation agrees with the descriptions given in the Purāṇas and similar works, it cannot be said to accord with Vedic literature. For the position and status of Indra stated in the Purāṇas and similar works, and the position and status of Indra stated in the Ṛgveda

(continuing the Special Topics of the preceding Ṛk)

...the status and rank of Indra in the Purāṇas and the like also differ greatly from those stated for Indra in the Ṛgveda. In the Purāṇas and the like Indra's rank is not of the highest. It says that there are deities above him, that Indra is an ordinary deity, and that he is lord of heaven alone. In the Vedas, however, Indra's position is said to be one of sovereignty: Indra alone is the best among all the deities. It was he who created earth and the atmosphere. In many places it is said that heaven and earth, the sun and moon, all other living beings and the whole creation are obedient to Indra's command, that Indra alone is the sole lord of the whole universe, and that he is the best of all the deities. Therefore there is room to say that the Indra of the Ṛgveda is the very principle of the Supreme Brahman stated in the Vedānta texts. In the Ṛgveda there are not as many hymns addressed to any other deity as to Indra. About 250 hymns, and some portions of hymns, praise Indra. Indra is also praised together with certain other deities. Taken all together, about 300 hymns are in his honour, which means about a quarter of the Ṛgveda. Indra's greatness and his deeds of daring are described more especially than those of all the other deities.

Moreover, it is said both in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā and in the Yajurveda that Indra is a son of Aditi, the mother of the gods:

अष्टौ पुत्रासो अदितेर्ये जातास्तन्वंस्परि । (*aṣṭau putrāso aditerye jātāstanvaṃspari |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-72-8)

अष्टौ पुत्रासो अदितेः । ये जातास्तन्वःपरि । देवाउप प्रैत्सप्तभिः । परामार्ताण्डमास्यत् । सप्तभिः पुत्रैरदितिः । उप प्रैत्तूर्व्यं युगं । प्रजायै मृत्युवे तत् । परामार्ताण्डमाभरदिति ।ताननुक्रमिष्यामः । मित्रश्च वरुणश्च । धाता चार्यमा च । अगंशुश्च भगश्च । इंद्रश्च विवस्वाग् श्चेत्येते ॥ (*aṣṭau putrāso aditeḥ | ye jātāstanvaḥpari | devāupa praitsaptabhiḥ | parāmārtāṃḍamāsyat | saptabhiḥ putrairaditiḥ | upa praittūrvyaṃ yugaṃ | prajāyai mṛtyuve tat | parāmārtāṃḍamābharaditi | tānanukramiṣyāmaḥ | mitraśca varuṇaśca | dhātā cāryamā ca | agaṃśuśca bhagaśca | iṃdraśca vivasvāg ścetyete ||*)

(Tai. Ā. 1-13-2, 3)

As stated here, Aditi has eight children, and their names are given as Mitra, Varuṇa, Dhātā, Āryamā, Aṃśu, Bhaga, Indra and Vivasvān. Since it is clearly stated that Indra is one of these eight, there is no doubt whatever that Aditi, the mother of the gods, is Indra's mother. As for his father being Kaśyapa, that is only a statement of the Purāṇas; there is no support for it in the Ṛgveda.

गिरिस्थां अंशोः पीयूषं (*giristhāṃ aṃśoḥ pīyūṣaṃ*)—here the use of the word गिरिस्थां (*giristhāṃ*) indicates Soma plants grown on mountains. Although the Soma plant also grows on plains and on river banks, the one grown on mountains is famed as the best. Moreover, the higher it grows the better it is, and it is famed as having more juice and being more pleasant to the taste. Among the mountains where the Soma plant grows, the mountain named Mūjavat is famed, and is mentioned in many places in the Ṛgveda.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒प॒स्थाय॑ मा॒तर॒मन्नं॑मैट्ट ति॒ग्ममं॑पश्यद॒भि सोम॒मूध॑ः

।

प्र॒या॒वयं॑न्नचर॒द्गृत्सो॑ अ॒न्यान्म॒हानि॑ चक्रे पुरु॒धप्र॑तीकः

॥ ३ ॥

> *upasthāya mātaramannamaiṭṭa tigmamapaśyadabhi somamūdhaḥ |*
> *prayāvayannacaradgṛtso anyānmahāni cakre purudhapratīkaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उपस्थाय । मातरं । अन्नं । ऐट्ट । तिग्मं । अपश्यत् । अभि । सोमं । ऊधः ।
> प्रयवयन् । अचरत् । गृत्सः । अन्यान् । महानि । चक्रे । पुरुध्रप्रतीकः ॥ ३ ॥

> *upasthāya | mātaram | annam | aiṭṭa | tigmam | apaśyat | abhi |*
> *somam | ūdhaḥ |*
> *prayavayan | acarat | gṛtsaḥ | anyān | mahāni | cakre |*
> *purudhrapratīkaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स इंद्रो मातरमुपस्थाय प्रार्थयित्वान्नमैट्ट । तामन्नमयाचत ।
> ईळिरध्येषणाकर्मेति यास्कः । ततस्तस्या ऊध ऊधसि क्षीररूपेण स्थितं तिग्मं दीप्तं
> सोममभ्य पश्यत् । सर्वतोऽदर्शत् । गृत्सः । अभिकांक्ष्यते सर्वैर्देवैः शत्रुहननार्थमिति गृत्स
> इंद्रः । अन्यान्सपत्नान्वयवयन् स्वस्वस्थानात्पकर्षणोच्चालयन्नचरत् । सर्वत्र चरति । किंच
> पुरुधप्रतीकस्तेजोयोगाद्बहुधा विक्षिप्तांगो
> महानि महांति वृत्रहननादीनि कर्माणि चक्रे ॥ उपस्थाय । तिष्ठतेर्लपि घुमास्थेतीत्वे प्राप्ने न
> ल्यपीति प्रतिषेधः । लित्स्वरः । ऐट्ट । ईळिर्याच्छार्थः । तस्माल्लजि
> रूपं । आडजादीनामित्याडागमः । ष्टुत्वं । निघातः । तिग्मं । तिज निशाने ।
> अस्माद्युजिरुचितिजां कुश्चति मक्प्रत्ययः कवर्गादिशश्च । प्रयवयन् । यु
> मिश्रणामिश्रणयोरित्यस्यण्यंतस्य शतरि रूपं । लित्स्वरः । गृत्सः । गृधु अभिकांक्षायां ।
> गृधिपण्योर्दका चेति सप्रत्ययो दकारश्चांतादेशः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ।
> पुरुधप्रतीकः । पुरुशब्द इह संख्यावाची । संख्याया विधार्थे धेति धाप्रत्ययः ।
> ह्रस्वश्छांदसः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *sa iṃdro mātaramupasthāya prārthayitvānnamaiṭṭa |*
> *tāmannamayācata |*
> *īḷiradhyeṣaṇākarmati yāskaḥ | tatastasyā ūdha ūdhasi kṣīrarūpeṇa sthitaṃ tigmaṃ dīptaṃ*
> *somamabhya paśyat | sarvato 'darśat | gṛtsaḥ | abhikāṃkṣyate sarvairdevaiḥ śatruhananārthamiti gṛtsa iṃdraḥ |*
> *anyānsapatnānvayavayan svasvasthānātpakarṣaṇoccālayannacarat | sarvatra carati | kiṃca purudhapratīkastejoyogādbahudhā vikṣiptāṃgo mahāni mahāṃti vṛtrahananādīni karmāṇi cakre ‖ upasthāya |*
> *tiṣṭhaterlapi ghumāsthetītve prāpne na lyapīti pratiṣedhaḥ | litsvaraḥ | aiṭṭa | īḷiryācchārthaḥ | tasmāllaji*
> *rūpaṃ | āḍajādīnāmityāḍāgamaḥ | ṣṭutvaṃ | nighātaḥ | tigmaṃ | tija niśāne | asmādyujirucitijāṃ kuścati makpratyayaḥ kavargādeśaśca |*
> *prayavayan | yu miśraṇāmiśraṇayorityasyaṇyaṃtasya śatari rūpaṃ | litsvaraḥ | gṛtsaḥ | gṛdhu abhikāṃkṣāyāṃ |*
> *gṛdhipaṇyordakā ceti sapratyayo dakāraścāṃtādeśaḥ |*
> *vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ |*
> *purudhapratīkaḥ | puruśabda iha saṃkhyāvācī | saṃkhyāyā vidhārthe dheti dhāpratyayaḥ |*
> *hrasvaśchāṃdasaḥ | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says that this Indra, approaching his mother, asked her for food (ऐट्ट (*aiṭṭa*)): he begged her for food. Yāska says that ईळि (*īḷi*) denotes the act of requesting. Then, in her udder, he saw all around the bright (तिग्मं (*tigmaṃ*)) Soma standing there in the form of milk. गृत्सः (*gṛtsaḥ*) is Indra, because he is desired by all the gods for the slaying of enemies. Driving the others, his rivals, away, dislodging them from their several places, he moved about everywhere. Further, being पुरुधप्रतीकः (*purudhapratīkaḥ*), with his limbs spread out in many ways through union with radiance, he performed great deeds such as the slaying of Vṛtra. (The rest of the block is grammatical.)

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra

- मातरं (*mātaraṃ*)—his mother
- उपस्थाय (*upasthāya*)—having approached
- अन्नं (*annaṃ*)—food
- ऐट्ट (*aiṭṭa*)—he begged
- ऊधः (*ūdhaḥ*)—that which is in her breast in the form of milk
- तिग्मं (*tigmaṃ*)—bright
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—Soma
- अभि अपश्यत् (*abhi apaśyat*)—he looked at fully
- गृत्सः (*gṛtsaḥ*)—Indra, who is desired by the gods
- अन्यान् (*anyān*)—enemies
- प्रयवयन् (*prayavayan*)—driving them out of their several places
- अचरत् (*acarat*)—moves about everywhere
- पुरुधप्रतीकः (*purudhapratīkaḥ*)—spread everywhere in his form of radiance
- महानि (*mahāni*)—very great deeds
- चक्रे (*cakre*)—he performed

Gist

Indra approached his mother and begged her for food. He looked fully at the bright Soma that was in her breast in the form of milk. Indra, who is desired by the gods, moves about everywhere driving the enemies out of their several places. Spread everywhere in his form of radiance, he performed very great deeds.

English translation

Approaching his mother he asked for food, and beheld the acrid Soma upon her bosom : eager he proceeds, dislodging the adversaries (of the gods) ; and, putting forth manifold (energy), he performed great (deeds).

Special Topics

In this Ṛk it is described that Indra begged his mother for अन्न (*anna*) (food), and saw that the milk in her breast was in the form of Soma.

ऐट्ट (*aiṭṭa*)—ईळिर्याच्चार्थः । (*īḷiryāccārthaḥ* |) ईळिरध्येषणाकर्मेति यास्कः । (*īḷiradhyeṣaṇākarmeti yāskaḥ* |) The meaning is: he desired, he begged.

गृत्सः (*gṛtsaḥ*)—For the word गृत्सः (*gṛtsaḥ*), formed from the root गृधु अभिकांक्षायां (*gṛdhu abhikāṃkṣāyāṃ*), the commentator gives the etymological sense: अभिकांक्ष्यते सर्वैर्देवैः शत्रुहननार्थमिति गृत्स इंद्रः । (*abhikāṃkṣyate sarvairdevaiḥ śatruhananārthamiti gṛtsa iṃdraḥ* |) That is, since all the deities desire Indra for the work of destroying enemies, Indra is called Gṛtsa.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒ग्रस्तु॑रा॒षाळ॒भिभू॑त्योजा यथाव॒शं त॒न्वं॑ चक्र ए॒षः ।
त्वष्टा॑र॒मिन्द्रो॑ ज॒नुषा॑भि॒भूया॒मुष्या॒ सोम॑मपिबच्च॒मूषु॑ ॥
४ ॥

> *ugrasturāṣāḷabhibhūtyojā yathāvaśaṃ tanvaṃ cakra eṣaḥ |*
> *tvaṣṭāramindro januṣābhibhūyāmuṣyā somamapibaccamūṣu ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उग्रः । तुराषाट् । अभिभूतिओजाः । यथावशं । तन्वं । चक्रे । विषः ।
> त्वष्टारं । इंद्रः । जनुषा । अभिभूय । आमुष्य । सोमं । अपिबत् । चमूषु ॥

> *ugraḥ | turāṣāṭ | abhibhūtiojāḥ | yathāvaśaṃ | tanvaṃ | cakre | viṣaḥ | tvaṣṭāraṃ | iṃdraḥ | januṣā | abhibhūya | āmuṣya | somaṃ | apibat | camūṣu ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> य एष इंद्र उग्रः शत्रोणां भयंकरस्तुराषाट् त्वरया शत्रोणामभिभविता
> अत एवाभिभूत्योजाः शत्रोणामभिभवनपराक्रमोपेतः सन् तन्वमात्मीयं शरीरं
> यथावशं यथाकामं नानाधिरूपोपेतं चक्रे । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । रूपंरूपं मघना बोभवीति ।
> ऋग्वे. ३-५३-८ । इति स इंद्रो जनुषा जन्मना सामर्थ्येन त्वष्टारं त्वष्टृनामकमसुरमभिभूय
> चमूषु चमसेषु स्थितमामुष्य
> चोरयित्वा सोममपिबत् । त्वष्टा हतपुत्रो वींद्रमित्यादि प्रासहा सोममपिबत्। तै. सं.
> २-४-१२। इति तैत्तिरीयकं॥ तुराषाट् । इत्वरा संभ्रमे । क्विप् । ज्वरत्वरेत्यादिना ऊट् ।
> सहेश्छंदसि सह इति ण्णिः । कर्तृकरणे कृता बहुलमिति समासः ।
> तत्पुरुषे कृति बहुलमिति तृतीयाया अलुक् । सहेः साडः स इति षत्वं । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः ।

> यथावशं । वशं काममनतिक्रम्येत्यव्ययीभावसमासः । समासस्वरः ।
> आमुष्य । मुष स्तेये । ल्यप् । चमूषु । चमु अदने । कृषिचमितनिधनिसर्जिखर्जिभ्य
> ऊरित्यूप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *ya eṣa iṃdra ugraḥ śatroṇāṃ bhayaṃkarasturāṣāṭ tvarayā*
> *śatroṇāmabhibhavitā*
> *ata evābhibhūtyojāḥ śatroṇāmabhibhavanaparākramopetaḥ san*
> *tanvamātmīyaṃ śarīraṃ*
> *yathāvaśaṃ yathākāmaṃ nānādhirūpopetaṃ cakre | tathā ca*
> *maṃtravarṇaḥ | rūpaṃrūpaṃ maghanā bobhavīti | ṛgve. 3-53-8 | iti sa*
> *iṃdro januṣā janmanā sāmarthyena tvaṣṭāraṃ*
> *tvaṣṭṛnāmakamasuramabhibhūya camūṣu camaseṣu sthitamāmuṣya*
> *corayitvā somamapibat | tvaṣṭā hataputro vīṃdramityādi prāsahā*
> *somamapibat| tai. saṃ. 2-4-12| iti taittirīyakaṃ‖ turāṣāṭ | itvarā*
> *saṃbhrame | kvip | jvaratvaretyādinā ūṭ | saheśchaṃdasi saha iti ṇṇiḥ |*
> *kartṛkaraṇe kṛtā bahulamiti samāsaḥ |*
> *tatpuruṣe kṛti bahulamiti tṛtīyāyā aluk | saheḥ sāḍaḥ sa iti ṣatvaṃ |*
> *kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | yathāvaśaṃ | vaśaṃ*
> *kāmamanatikramyetyavyayībhāvasamāsaḥ | samāsasvaraḥ |*
> *āmuṣya | muṣa steye | lyap | camūṣu | camu adane |*
> *kṛṣicamitanidhanisarjikharjibhya ūrityūpratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says that this Indra is उग्रः (*ugraḥ*), terrible to enemies; तुराषाट् (*turāṣāṭ*), one who overcomes enemies with speed; hence अभिभूत्योजाः (*abhibhūtyojāḥ*), endowed with the might to overpower enemies. Being so, he made (चक्रे (*cakre*)) his own body यथावशं (*yathāvaśaṃ*), according to his wish, endowed with many kinds of forms. So too there is a mantra text: रूपंरूपं मघना बोभवीति (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ maghanā bobhavīti*) (Ṛgveda 3-53-8). That Indra, जनुषा (*januṣā*), by birth, that is, by his native power, overcame the Asura named Tvaṣṭṛ, stole the Soma lying in the ladles (चमूषु (*camūṣu*), that is, in the cups), and drank it. The Taittirīya text says: त्वष्टा हतपुत्रो वींद्रमित्यादि प्रासहा सोममपिबत्। (*tvaṣṭā hataputro vīṃdramityādi prāsahā somamapibat*|) (Tai. Saṃ. 2-4-12). (The rest of the block is grammatical.)

Word-to-word meaning

- एषः (*eṣaḥ*)—this Indra
- उग्रः (*ugraḥ*)—being terrible
- तुराषाट् (*turāṣāṭ*)—one who defeats enemies
- अभिभूत्योजाः (*abhibhūtyojāḥ*)—possessing the brilliance that conquers enemies
- तन्नं (*tannaṃ*)—his body
- यथावशं (*yathāvaśaṃ*)—as he pleased
- चक्रे (*cakre*)—he changed
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—that same Indra
- जनुषा (*januṣā*)—by his natural power
- त्वष्टारं (*tvaṣṭāraṃ*)—the Asura named Tvaṣṭṛ
- अभिभूय (*abhibhūya*)—having defeated
- चमूषु (*camūṣu*)—that was in the ladle-vessel
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- आमुष्य (*āmuṣya*)—having carried off
- अपिबत् (*apibat*)—drank

Gist

This Indra, being terrible, a defeater of enemies, and possessed of the brilliance that conquers enemies, changed his body as he pleased. That same Indra, by his natural power, defeated the Asura named Tvaṣṭṛ, carried off the Soma that was in the ladle-vessel, and drank it.

English translation

Fierce, rapid in assault, of overpowering strength, he made his form obedient to his will; having overcome Twashtri by his innate (vigour), and carried off the Soma juice, he drank it (deposited) in the ladles.

Special Topics

तुराषाट् (*turāṣāṭ*)—त्वरया शत्रूणामभिभवता । (*tvarayā śatrūṇāmabhibhavatā* |) Because he defeats enemies very quickly, Indra has the name तुराषाट् (*turāṣāṭ*).

अभिभूत्योजाः (*abhibhūtyojāḥ*)—शत्रुणामभिभवनपराक्रमोपेतः । (*śatruṇāmabhibhavanaparākramopetaḥ* |) The meaning is that Indra is endowed with the greatest prowess for defeating enemies. That is why the epithet उग्रः (*ugraḥ*), "terrible to enemies", is stated here.

यथावशं तन्नं चक्रे एषः (*yathāvaśaṃ tannaṃ cakre eṣaḥ*)—तन्नमात्मीयं शरीरं यथाकामं नानाविधरूपोपेतं चक्रे । (*tannamātmīyaṃ śarīraṃ yathākāmaṃ nānāvidharūpopetaṃ cakre* |) Since Indra is capable of taking on, in order to defeat enemies, the various forms that he likes, it is said here that at the time of destroying enemies he assumes whatever form (shape) he pleases. On this matter:

रूपंरूपं मघवा बोभवीति मायाः कृण्वानस्तन्वं परि स्वां । (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ maghavā bobhavīti māyāḥ kṛṇvānastanvaṃ pari svāṃ* |)

रूपंरूपं प्रतिरूपो बभूव तदस्य रूपं प्रतिचक्षणाय । इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते युक्ता ह्यस्य हरयः शता दश ॥ (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ pratirūpo babhūva tadasya rūpaṃ praticakṣaṇāya | iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate yuktā hyasya harayaḥ śatā daśa* ||)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-18)

In Ṛks such as these it is said that, in order to conquer the Asuras who are masters of illusion, Indra assumes whatever forms he needs.

Regarding Indra overcoming Tvaṣṭṛ, carrying off the Soma in the ladles and drinking it: स इंद्रो जन्मना सामर्थ्येन त्वष्टनामकमसुरमभिभूय अस्य चमसपात्रेषु स्थितं सोमं चोरयित्वापिबत् । (*sa iṃdro janmanā sāmarthyena tvaṣṭanāmakamasuramabhibhūya asya camasapātreṣu sthitaṃ somaṃ corayitvāpibat* |) That Indra, by his own power, defeated the Asura named Tvaṣṭṛ, stole the Soma that Tvaṣṭṛ had placed in the ladle-vessels so that he might drink it, and drank it himself. Here Tvaṣṭṛ is described as an Asura. But this Tvaṣṭṛ is one of the Prajāpatis and the architect of the gods, and there are plenty of Ṛks in the Ṛgveda praising him. However, his son named Viśvarūpa, though priest to the gods, favoured the Asuras; therefore his father Tvaṣṭṛ too is called an Asura here. On this matter the commentator has given an itihāsa from the Taittirīya Saṃhitā as an example—

त्वष्टा हतपुत्रो वींद्रगं् सोममाहरत्तस्मिन्निंद्र उपहवमैच्छत तन्नोपाह्वयत पुत्रं मेऽवधीरिति स यज्ञवेशसं तृत्वा प्रासहा सोममपिबत्तस्य यदत्यशिष्यत तत्त्वष्टाहवनीयमुप प्रावर्तयत्स्वाहेंद्रशत्रुर्वर्धस्वेति । (*tvaṣṭā hataputro vīṃdragṃ somamāharattasminniṃdra upahavamaicchata tannopāhvayata putraṃ me 'vadhīriti sa yajñaveśasaṃ tṛtvā prāsahā somamapibattasya yadatyaśiṣyata tattvaṣṭāhavanīyamupa prāvartayatsvāheṃdraśatrurvardhasveti |*)

(Tai. Saṃ. 2-4-12-1)

The Prajāpati Tvaṣṭṛ had a son named Viśvarūpa. Indra killed him for a certain reason. Enraged at this, Tvaṣṭṛ wished for a son who would kill Indra, and began to perform a sacrifice. But in that sacrifice, out of anger at Indra, that is, out of anger that he had killed his son, he did not invite Indra to the sacrifice and did not give him the Soma-drink. Indra, enraged at this, created an obstacle to his sacrifice and forcibly drank the Soma juice that was there. Unable to bear this, Tvaṣṭṛ poured the remainder of the Soma that Indra had left after drinking into the Āhavanīya fire and wished for a son who would kill Indra; and so on. The commentator has explained the meaning thus: what is stated here is the very matter of Indra's forcibly drinking the Soma.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शु॒नं हु॑वेम म॒घवा॑न॒मिन्द्र॑म॒स्मिन्भ॒रे नृत॑मं॒ वाज॑सातौ
।
शृ॒ण्वन्त॑मु॒ग्रमू॒तये॑ स॒मत्सु॒ घ्नन्तं॑ वृ॒त्राणि॑ सं॒जितं॒ धना॑
नाम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *śunaṃ huvema maghavānamindramasminbhare nṛtamaṃ vājasātau |*
> *śṛṇvantamugramūtaye samatsu ghnantaṃ vṛtrāṇi saṃjitaṃ dhanānām ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुनं । हुवेम । मघवानं । इंद्रं । आस्मिन् । भरे । नृतमं । वाजसात् ।
> शृण्वंतं । उग्रं । ऊतये । समत्सु । घ्नंतं । वृत्राणि । संजितं । धनानां ॥

> *śunaṃ | huvema | maghavānaṃ | iṃdraṃ | āsmin | bhare | nṛtamaṃ | vājasāt |*
> *śṛṇvaṃtaṃ | ugraṃ | ūtaye | samatsu | ghnaṃtaṃ | vṛtrāṇi | saṃjitaṃ | dhanānāṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वाजसात् । वाजस्यान्नस्य सातिर्लाभो यस्मिन् सोऽयं वाजसातिः। अस्मिन्भरे । बिभ्रति जयलक्ष्मीमनेन योद्धार इति भरः संग्रामः । तस्मिन् संग्रामे शुनं शूनमुत्साहेन प्रवृद्धं । यद्वा शुनमिति सुखनाम । सुखकरं शुघवानं धनवंतं अत एवेंद्रं निरतिशयैश्वर्यसंपन्नं नृतमं सर्वस्य जगतोऽतिशयेन नेतारं त्वां हुवेम । कुशिका वयं यज्ञार्थमाह्वयेम । तथा शृण्वंतमस्माभिः

> *he iṃdra vājasāt | vājasyānnasya sātirlābho yasmin so 'yaṃ vājasātiḥ| asminbhare | bibhrati jayalakṣmīmanena yoddhāra iti bharaḥ saṃgrāmaḥ | tasmin saṃgrāme śunaṃ śūnamutsāhena pravṛddhaṃ | yadvā śunamiti sukhanāma | sukhakaraṃ śughavānaṃ dhanavaṃtaṃ ata eveṃdraṃ niratiśayaiśvaryasaṃpannaṃ nṛtamaṃ sarvasya jagato 'tiśayena netāraṃ tvāṃ huvema | kuśikā vayaṃ yajñārthamāhvayema | tathā śṛṇvaṃtamasmābhiḥ*

> क्रियमाणां स्तुतिं शृण्वंतमुग्रं शत्रूणां भयंकरं समत्तु संग्रामेषु वृत्राणि वृत्रोपलक्षितानि सर्वाणि रक्षांसि घ्नंतं हिंसंतं धनानां शत्रुसंबंधिनां संजितं सम्यग्वेतारं त्वामूतये रक्षणाय वयमाह्वयेम ॥ शुनं । टुओश्वि गतिवृद्ध्योरित्यस्य निष्ठायां यस्य विभाषेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । दीर्घाभावश्छांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हुवेम । ह्वयतेर्बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणे कृते शपो लुकि कृते च लिङ् रूपं । निघातः । भरे । भृञ् भरणे । घः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः । वाजसात् । षणु दाने । भावे क्तिन् । जनसनेत्यादिनानुनासिकस्यात्वं । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपवस्वरः । समत्तु । अद भक्षणे । संपूर्वात् क्विप् । संभक्षयंति योद्धणामायूंषीति समदः संग्रामाः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । घ्नंतं । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य शतरि गमहनेत्यादिनोपधालोपः । हो हंतेरिति घत्वं । संजितं । जि जये । क्विप् ॥

> *kriyamāṇāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇvaṃtamugraṃ śatrūṇāṃ bhayaṃkaraṃ samattu saṃgrāmeṣu vṛtrāṇi*
> *vṛtropalakṣitāni sarvāṇi rakṣāṃsi ghnaṃtaṃ hiṃsaṃtaṃ dhanānāṃ śatrusaṃbaṃdhināṃ saṃjitaṃ*
> *samyagvetāraṃ tvāmūtaye rakṣaṇāya vayamāhvayema ‖ śunaṃ | ṭuośvi gativṛddhyorityasya niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya vibhāṣetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ |*
> *yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *huvema | hyayaterbahulaṃ chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe kṛte*
> *śapo luki kṛte ca liṅ rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | bhare | bhṛñ bharaṇe | ghaḥ |*
> *vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ | vājasāt | ṣaṇu dāne | bhāve ktin |*
> *janasanetyādinānunāsikasyātvaṃ |*
> *bahuvrīhau pūrvapavasvaraḥ | samattu | ada bhakṣaṇe | saṃpūrvāt kvip | saṃbhakṣayaṃti*
> *yoddhaṇāmāyūṃṣīti samadaḥ saṃgrāmāḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ |*
> *ghnaṃtaṃ | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya śatari*
> *gamahanetyādinopadhālopaḥ | ho haṃteriti ghatvaṃ | saṃjitaṃ |*
> *ji jaye | kvip ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: "O Indra, वाजसात् (*vājasāt*): that in which there is साति (*sāti*), gain, of वाज (*vāja*), food, is वाजसाति (*vājasāti*). भरे (*bhare*): since warriors bear (बिभ्रति (*bibhrati*)) the fortune of victory by it, भर (*bhara*) is battle. In this battle we call you, शुनं (*śunaṃ*), swollen, grown strong through zeal. Or else शुनं (*śunaṃ*) is a name for happiness: one who gives happiness. You are मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*), possessed of wealth, hence Indra, endowed with unsurpassed lordship, and नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*), in the highest degree the leader of the whole world. We, the Kuśikas, would call you for the sacrifice. Likewise, hearing the praise made by us..." (the sentence continues on the next page).

(The sentence continues:) ..."fierce, terrible to enemies; समत्तु (*samattu*), in battles, slaying (घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)) all the demons that are marked by Vṛtra; and a thorough conqueror (संजितं (*saṃjitaṃ*)) of the wealth (धनानां (*dhanānāṃ*)) that belongs to enemies: we call you, for protection (ऊतये (*ūtaye*))." (The remainder of the block is grammatical. It also explains समत्सु (*samatsu*) as follows: they thoroughly devour the lives of warriors, therefore समदः (*samadaḥ*) are battles.)

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)—which proceeds for the sake of food
- भरे (*bhare*)—in battle
- शुनं (*śunaṃ*)—one who increases through zeal, or one who produces happiness
- मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)—wealthy
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—endowed with unsurpassed wealth
- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—the leader: you
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—we call, praying
- शृण्वंतं (*śṛṇvaṃtaṃ*)—one who listens to (our praises)
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—terrible to enemies
- समत्तु (*samattu*)—in battles
- वृत्राणि (*vṛtrāṇi*)—the Asuras beginning with Vṛtra
- घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)—one who strikes and destroys
- धनानां (*dhanānāṃ*)—the wealth (of enemies)
- संचितं (*saṃcitaṃ*)—you who gather it and give it (to us)[?47]
- ऊतये (*ūtaye*)—for protection
- (हुवेम (*huvema*)—we call, praying)

Gist

O Indra, in the battle that proceeds for the sake of food, you who give happiness, are wealthy, endowed with unsurpassed wealth, are the leader, listen to our praises, are terrible to enemies, strike and destroy in battles the Asuras beginning with Vṛtra, and gather and give us the wealth of the enemies: we call you, praying, for protection.

English translation

We invoke for our protection the opulent Indra, distinguished in this combat, the leader in the food-bestowing (strife), hearing (our praises), terri-ble in battles, the destroyer of foes, the conqueror of wealth.

Special Topics

The special topics of this Ṛk have already been explained earlier.

Sūkta 49 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> शंसा महामिति पंचर्चमेकादशं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभमैंद्रं ।
> शंसा महामित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥ समूळ्हे दशरात्रेष्टमेऽहनि मरुत्वतीयशस्त्र एतत्तूक्तं । सूत्रितं च ।
> शंसा महां महश्चित्त्वमिंद्र । आ. ८–७ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु—शंसा महां ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हन्नॊंदनॆय
> सूक्तवु. इदरल्लि ऐदु ऋक्कुगळिरुवुवु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु ; इंद्रनु देवतॆयु ;
> त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि शंसा महां ऎंदु मॊदलागि हेळिरुवुदु. समूळ
> दशरात्रवॆंब यागद ऎंटनॆय दिवस मरुत्वतीय शस्त्रमंत्रगळिगागि ई सूक्तद विनियोग
> विरुवुदॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—शंसा महां महश्चित्त्वमिंद्र ऎंब सूत्रदिंद विवृत
> वागिरुवुदु (आ. ८–७).
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—४९
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—४९ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—१३ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—५ ॥
> । ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ।
> । देवता—इंद्रः ।
> । छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ।

> *śaṃsā mahāmiti paṃcarcamekādaśaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ traiṣṭubhamaiṃdraṃ |*
> *śaṃsā mahāmityanukramaṇikā ‖ samūḻhe daśarātreṣṭame 'hani marutvatīyaśastra etattūktaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | śaṃsā mahāṃ mahaścittvamiṃdra | ā. 8-7 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—śaṃsā mahāṃ èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli hannòṃdanèya*
> *sūktavu. idaralli aidu ṛkkugaḻiruvuvu. ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu ; iṃdranu devatèyu ;*
> *triṣṭup chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli śaṃsā mahāṃ èṃdu mòdalāgi heḻiruvudu. samūḻa*
> *daśarātravèṃba yāgada èṃṭanèya divasa marutvatīya śastramaṃtragaḻigāgi ī sūktada viniyoga*
> *viruvudèṃdu āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—śaṃsā mahāṃ*

> *mahaścittvamiṃdra èṃba sūtradiṃda vivṛta*
> *vāgiruvudu (ā. 8-7).*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—49*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—49 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—13 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—5 ‖*
> *| ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ |*
> *| devatā—iṃdraḥ |*
> *| chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

This is the eleventh sūkta of the fourth anuvāka, of five ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, its deity Indra, its metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā marks it with the words शंसा महां (*śaṃsā mahāṃ*). It is used in the Marutvatīya śastra on the eighth day of the Samūḷha Daśarātra sacrifice, as the sūtra shows: शंसा महां महश्चित्त्वमिंद्र (*śaṃsā mahāṃ mahaścittvamiṃdra*) (Ā. Sū. 8-7). The block also gives the particulars: Maṇḍala 3, Anuvāka 4, Sūkta 49, Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 3, Varga 13, five ṛks.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शंसा॑ म॒हामिन्द्रं॒ यस्मि॒न्विश्वा॒ आ कृ॒ष्टय॑ः सोम॒पाः
काम॒मव्य॑न् ।
यं सु॒क्रतुं᳚ धि॒षणे॑ विभ्वत॒ष्टं घ॒नं वृ॒त्राणां᳚ ज॒नय॑न्त
दे॒वाः ॥ १ ॥

> *śaṃsā mahāmindraṃ yasminviśvā ā kṛṣṭayaḥ somapāḥ kāmamavyan |*
> *yaṃ sukratuṃ dhiṣaṇe vibhvataṣṭaṃ ghanaṃ vṛtrāṇāṃ janayanta devāḥ*
> *‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शंस महां । इंद्रं । यस्मिन् । विश्वाः । आ । कृष्टयः । सोमपाः । कामं ।
> अव्वन् ।
> यं । सुक्रतुं । धिषणे इति । विभ्वतष्टं । घनं । वृत्राणां । जनयंत । देवाः ॥

> *śaṃsa mahāṃ | iṃdraṃ | yasmin | viśvāḥ | ā | kṛṣṭayaḥ | somapāḥ | kāmaṃ |*
> *avvan |*
> *yaṃ | sukratuṃ | dhiṣaṇe iti | vibhvataṣṭaṃ | ghanaṃ | vṛtrāṇāṃ | janayaṃta | devāḥ ||*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे होत महां महांतमिंड्रं शंस । शस्त्रैः स्तुहि । यस्मिन्निंद्रे रक्षितरि
> सति विश्वाः कृस्टयः सर्वे मनुष्याः सोमपा यज्ञमनुष्ठाय सोमपाः संतः
> कामं । काम्यत इति कामः स्वर्गादिः । तमाव्यन् सर्वतः प्राप्नुवंति । धिषणे देवमनुष्यादीनां
> धारयित्र्यौ । यद्वा । प्रगल्ले समर्थे स्वाश्रितान् रक्षितुमिति धिषणे
> द्यावापृथिव्यौ । देवाश्च सुक्रतुं । क्रतुः कर्म जगत्पालनादि । शोभनः क्रतुर्यस्यासौ सुक्रतुः ।
> तादृशं विभृतष्टं विभुना ब्रह्मणा जगदाधिपत्ये स्थापितं महांतं
> वृत्राणां पापरूपाणां घनं हंतारं यमिंद्रं जनयंत । अजनयन् ॥ शंस ।
> शन्नु स्तुतावित्यस्य लोटि रूपं । पादादित्वादनिघातः द्व्यचोऽतस्तिज इति
> संहितायां दीर्घः । अव्यन् । वी कांतिगत्यादिषु । लजि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । अट्
> स्वरः । सुक्रतुं । क्रत्वादयश्चेत्युत्तरसदाद्युदात्तः । धिषणे । इं
> धृषा प्रागल्ब इत्यस्माद्धषेर्धिष च संज्ञायामिति कु प्रत्ययः । धिष इत्यादेशः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । घनं । हंतेः पुंसि संज्ञायामिति घः । हो हंतेरिति कुत्वं । प्रत्ययस्वरः । जनयंत
> । जनेर्न्यंतस्य लजि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ॥

> *he hota mahāṃ mahāṃtamiṃḍraṃ śaṃsa | śastraiḥ stuhi |*
> *yasminniṃdre rakṣitari*
> *sati viśvāḥ kṛsṭayaḥ sarve manuṣyāḥ somapā yajñamanuṣṭhāya somapāḥ saṃtaḥ*
> *kāmaṃ | kāmyata iti kāmaḥ svargādiḥ | tamāvyan sarvataḥ prāpnuvaṃti | dhiṣaṇe devamanuṣyādīnāṃ dhārayitryau | yadvā |*
> *pragalle samarthe svāśritān rakṣitumiti dhiṣaṇe*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyau | devāśca sukratuṃ | kratuḥ karma jagatpālanādi | śobhanaḥ kraturyasyāsau sukratuḥ | tādṛśaṃ vibhṛtaṣṭaṃ vibhunā brahmaṇā jagadādhipatye sthāpitaṃ mahāṃtaṃ*
> *vṛtrāṇāṃ pāparūpāṇāṃ ghanaṃ haṃtāraṃ yamiṃdraṃ janayaṃta |*

> *ajanayan ‖ śaṃsa |*
> *śannu stutāvityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | pādāditvādanighātaḥ dvyaco 'tastija iti saṃhitāyāṃ dīrghaḥ | avyan | vī kāṃtigatyādiṣu | laji rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | aṭ svaraḥ | sukratuṃ | kratvādayaścetyuttarasadādyudāttaḥ | dhiṣaṇe | iṃ dhṛṣā prāgalba ityasmāddaṣerdhiṣa ca saṃjñāyāmiti ku pratyayaḥ | dhiṣa ityādeśaḥ |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ | ghanaṃ | haṃteḥ puṃsi saṃjñāyāmiti ghaḥ | ho haṃteriti kutvaṃ | pratyayasvaraḥ | janayaṃta | janernyaṃtasya laji rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Hotṛ, praise the great Indra with the śastras. Under the protection of this Indra, all men, having performed the sacrifice and become Soma-drinkers, obtain their desire." Kāma is what is desired, heaven and the like; Sāyaṇa glosses the verb as "they obtain it fully". The two धिषणे (*dhiṣaṇe*) are the two sustainers of gods, men and others. Or else they are bold and capable of protecting those who depend on them, that is, heaven and earth. The gods too (beget Indra). सुक्रतुं (*sukratuṃ*): kratu is work, such as the protection of the world; he whose work is excellent is sukratu. विभ्वतष्टं (*vibhvataṣṭaṃ*): established by Vibhu, that is Brahmā, in the sovereignty of the world. He is great, the घनं (*ghanaṃ*), the slayer of the Vṛtras, who are of the nature of sin. This Indra they begot.

Word-to-word meaning

- यस्मिन् (*yasmin*)—in whose (Indra's) protection (O Hotṛ)
- विश्वाः (*viśvāḥ*)—all
- कृष्टयः (*kṛṣṭayaḥ*)—men
- सोमपा (*somapā*)—having drunk Soma (at the close of the sacrifice)
- कामं (*kāmaṃ*)—their desired object
- अव्यन् (*avyan*)—obtain fully; (and)
- धिषणे (*dhiṣaṇe*)—heaven and earth, which sustain all
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—all the gods as well
- सुक्रतुं (*sukratuṃ*)—the excellent doer of deeds

- विभ्वतष्टं (*vibhvataṣṭaṃ*)—one established by Vibhu for the sovereignty of the world
- वृत्राणां (*vṛtrāṇāṃ*)—of Vṛtra and the other Asuras
- घनं (*ghanaṃ*)—the destroyer
- यं (*yaṃ*)—whom, that Indra
- जनयंत (*janayaṃta*)—caused to be born, such a one
- महां (*mahāṃ*)—of great nature
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- शंस (*śaṃsa*)—praise by reciting the śastras

Gist

O Hotṛ, praise with the recitation of the śastra-mantras that Indra of great nature, in whose protection all men, after performing the sacrifice and drinking Soma, obtain their desired object; whom heaven and earth, which sustain all, and all the gods also caused to be born: the excellent doer of deeds, established by Vibhu for the sovereignty of the world, the destroyer of Vṛtra and the other Asuras.

English translation

I glorify the mighty Indra, in whom all men, drinking the Soma juice, obtain their wishes ; whom the powerful (heaven and earth) and the gods begot, the doer of great deeds, the slayer of the Vritras, who was fashioned by Vibhu (the creator)

Special Topics

शंस महां इंद्रं (*śaṃsa mahāṃ iṃdraṃ*)—"O Hotṛ, praise in this sacrifice the greatly glorious Indra with śastra-mantras and the like": thus the sacrificer addresses the priest called Hotṛ. What the glory of Indra is, which is meant by the epithet महां (*mahāṃ*) ("greatly glorious"), the seer describes in the following sentences.

यस्मिन् विश्वाः आ कृष्टयः सोमपाः कामं अव्यन् (*yasmin viśvāḥ ā kṛṣṭayaḥ somapāḥ kāmaṃ avyan*)—इंद्रे रक्षतरि सति सर्वे मनुष्याः यज्ञमनुष्ठाय सोमपाः संतः स्वर्गादिकामं सर्वतः प्राप्नुवंति (*iṃdre rakṣatari sati sarve manuṣyāḥ yajñamanuṣṭhāya somapāḥ saṃtaḥ svargādikāmaṃ sarvataḥ prāpnuvaṃti*). While the all-powerful Indra protects, all men perform sacrifices and other

good rites, drink the Soma prescribed in those sacrifices, and as the fruit of it obtain the joys of heaven and the like. This is possible only through the glory of Indra.

धीषणे देवाः सुक्रतुं विभ्वतष्टं वृत्राणां हंतारं यं जनयंत (*dhīṣaṇe devāḥ sukratuṃ vibhvataṣṭaṃ vṛtrāṇāṃ haṃtāraṃ yaṃ janayaṃta*)—Since the word धि (*dhi*) is read among the names of rites, the word धीषणे (*dhīṣaṇe*) may be explained as heaven and earth, which are capable in the rites that protect people, or all the creatures on the earth. It is said here that such heaven and earth, and the gods, produced Indra. That Indra, being capable of performing rites such as the protection of the world, is praised by the epithet सुक्रतुं (*sukratuṃ*); being established by Brahmā in the sovereignty of the world, by विभ्वतष्टं (*vibhvataṣṭaṃ*); and being the destroyer of sins, by घनं वृत्राणां (*ghanaṃ vṛtrāṇāṃ*). It is said here that heaven and earth and the gods produced such a greatly glorious Indra. The matter of heaven and earth producing Indra we have already mentioned earlier.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यं नु न॒कि॒ः पृत॑नासु स्व॒राजं॑ द्वि॒ता तर॑ति॒ नृत॑मं ह॒रि॒ष्ठाम् ।
इ॒नत॑म॒ः सत्व॑भि॒र्यो ह॑ शू॒षैः पृ॑थु॒ज्रया॑ अमि॒नादायु॒र्दस्यो॑ः ॥ २ ॥

> *yaṃ nu nakiḥ pṛtanāsu svarājaṃ dvitā tarati nṛtamaṃ hariṣṭhām |*
> *inatamaḥ satvabhiryo ha śūṣaiḥ pṛthujrayā aminādāyurdasyoḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यं । नु । नकिः । पृतनासु । स्वराजं । द्विता । तरति । नृतमं । हरिस्थां ।
> इनतमः । सत्वभिः । यः । ह । शूषैः । पृथुज्रयाः । अमिनात् । आयुः ।
> दस्योः ॥ २ ॥

> *yaṃ | nu | nakiḥ | pṛtanāsu | svarājaṃ | dvitā | tarati | nṛtamaṃ | haristhāṃ |*
> *inatamaḥ | satvabhiḥ | yaḥ | ha | śūṣaiḥ | pṛthujrayāḥ | amināt | āyuḥ |*
> *dasyoḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पृतासु । व्याप्रियंतेऽत्र योद्धार इति पृतनाः संग्रामाः । तेषु स्वराजं
> हरिष्ठां हरिस्थां हरियुक्ते रथे वर्तमानं नृतमं बलस्य युद्धे नेतृतमं द्विता
> युद्ध मासाद्य सेनां द्विधा कृत्वा वर्तमानं यमिंद्रं नकिर्न कश्चिषपि तरति उत्तीर्य गच्छति । न कोऽप्यभ्यस्तीत्यर्थः । नु प्रसिद्धौ । स इंद्र इनतमोऽतिशयेन सेनास्वामी सत्वभिः परितः सीदद्भिर्मरुद्भिः सह यो यान् गच्छन् शूष्यैः । शोषयंति
> परबलानीति शूषाणि बलानि । तैः पृथुज्रया युद्धं प्रति तीव्रवेगः सन् दस्यो
> शत्रोरायुरन्नं प्राणं वामिनात् । हिनस्ति । ह प्रसिद्धौ ॥ अत्र निरुक्तं । पृथुज्रयाः पृथुजवः । पृथुज्रया अमिनादायुर्दस्योः । प्रामापयुदायुर्दस्योः
> । ५–९ । इति ॥ तरति । त्य प्लवनतरणयोरित्यस्य लट रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । शपः पित्तादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । यः । या प्रापणी । औणादिकः कप्रत्ययः ।
> आतो लोपः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *pṛtāsu | vyāpriyaṃte 'tra yoddhāra iti pṛtanāḥ saṃgrāmāḥ | teṣu svarājaṃ*
> *hariṣṭhāṃ haristhāṃ hariyukte rathe vartamānaṃ nṛtamaṃ balasya yuddhe netṛtamaṃ dvitā*
> *yuddha māsādya senāṃ dvidhā kṛtvā vartamānaṃ yamiṃdraṃ nakirna kaściṣapi tarati uttīrya gacchati | na ko 'pyabhyastītyarthaḥ | nu prasiddhau | sa iṃdra inatamo 'tiśayena senāsvāmī satvabhiḥ paritaḥ sīdadvirmarudbhiḥ saha yo yān gacchan śūṣyaiḥ | śoṣayaṃti*
> *parabalānīti śūṣāṇi balāni | taiḥ pṛthujrayā yuddhaṃ prati tīvravegaḥ san dasyo*
> *śatrorāyurannaṃ prāṇaṃ vāmināt | hinasti | ha prasiddhau ‖ atra niruktaṃ | pṛthujrayāḥ pṛthujavaḥ | pṛthujrayā aminādāyurdasyoḥ | prāmāpayudāyurdasyoḥ*
> *| 5-9 | iti ‖ tarati | tya plavanataraṇayorityasya laṭa rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *śapaḥ pittādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | yaḥ | yā prāpaṇī | auṇādikaḥ kapratyayaḥ |*
> *āto lopaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Pṛtanās are battles, where warriors engage. In them Indra is स्वराजं (*svarājaṃ*), self-ruling; हरिष्ठां (*hariṣṭhāṃ*) is हरिस्थां (*haristhāṃ*), standing in a chariot yoked with bay horses; नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*) is the best leader of strength in battle; द्विता (*dvitā*) means that, having come to battle, he proceeds dividing the enemy army in two. No one at all surpasses (तरति (*tarati*)) this Indra; the sense is that no one equals him. नु (*nu*) is a particle of well-known fact. That Indra, इनतमः (*inatamaḥ*), the greatest lord of the army, goes with the Maruts, the सत्वभिः (*satvabhiḥ*), who sit round about him. With his शूषैः (*śūṣaiḥ*), strengths that dry up (shoṣayanti) the forces of the foe, and being पृथुज्रयाः (*pṛthujrayāḥ*), of intense speed toward battle, he destroys the life, or the food, of the Dasyu, the enemy; ह (*ha*) is a particle of well-known fact. Sāyaṇa cites the Nirukta here, which explains पृथुज्रयाः (*pṛthujrayāḥ*) as पृथुजवः (*pṛthujavaḥ*) and then quotes the pāda of the ṛk, with a further word that is not clear (Ni. 5-9).[?48]

Word-to-word meaning

- कृतनासु (*kṛtanāsu*)—in battles
- स्वराजं (*svarājaṃ*)—shining by his own radiance
- हरिष्ठां (*hariṣṭhāṃ*)—seated in a chariot yoked with horses
- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—the most excellent leader
- द्विता (*dvitā*)—dividing the enemy army into two
- यं (*yaṃ*)—that same Indra
- नकिः (*nakiḥ*)—no one at all
- तरति (*tarati*)—can surpass him
- इनतमः (*inatamaḥ*)—as the most excellent commander
- सत्वभिः (*satvabhiḥ*)—moving about with his companions the Maruts
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Indra
- शूषैः (*śūṣaiḥ*)—with strength that dries up enemies
- प्रथुज्रयाः (*prathujrayāḥ*)—running swiftly toward the battle
- आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—the life of the enemy
- अविनात् (*avināt*)—destroys

Gist

That same Indra, who shines in battles by his own radiance, is seated in a chariot yoked with horses, is the most excellent leader, and divides the enemy army in two, no one can surpass. As the most excellent commander, moving about with his companions the Maruts, running swiftly toward the battle with his enemy-withering strength, Indra destroys the lives of the enemies.

English translation

Whom, when borne by his steeds, foremost and eminent in battles, breaking in two the (hostile host), no one ever surpasses : supreme in sway, attended by his faithful Maruts, and hastening to combat, he has destroyed with foe-withering (energies) the existence of the Dasyu.

Special Topics

नकिः (*nakiḥ*)—Yāska says that the word नकिः (*nakiḥ*) is used in the sense of the nine "all-words" collection (sarvapada-samāmnāya), हिकं नुकं (*hikaṃ nukaṃ*) and the others (Ni. 3-13). In the present ṛk the meaning न कश्चिदसि (*na kaścidasi*), "no one is able", is stated for this word.[?49]

नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—नेतृतमं (*netṛtamaṃ*): the best among leaders or chiefs.

हरिष्ठां (*hariṣṭhāṃ*)—हरियुक्तेरथे वर्तमानं (*hariyukterathe vartamānaṃ*). The two horses of Indra are called Hari (Ni. 2-28). The sense is: Indra seated in a chariot to which such horses are yoked.

इनतमः (*inatamaḥ*)—The word इन (*ina*) means lord. इनतमः (*inatamaḥ*) means one who is lord in an eminent or the highest degree.

पृथुज्रयाः (*pṛthujrayāḥ*)—Yāska, taking this very ṛk as the example, gives the explanation पृथुज्रयाः पृथुजवः (*pṛthujrayāḥ pṛthujavaḥ*), "of extended speed", that is, one of great speed (Ni. 5-9).

आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—Since the word आयुः (*āyuḥ*) means food (Ni. 3-9) and also life-breath or lifespan (Ni. 10-34), both meanings can be given here.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒हावा॑ पृ॒त्सु त॒रणि॒र्नार्वा॑ व्यान॒शी रोद॑सी मे॒हना॑वान् ।
भगो॒ न का॒रे हव्यो॑ मती॒नां पि॒तेव॒ चारु॑ः सु॒हवो॑ वयो॒धाः ॥ ३ ॥

> *sahāvā pṛtsu taraṇirnārvā vyānaśī rodasī mehanāvān |*
> *bhago na kāre havyo matīnāṃ piteva cāruḥ suhavo vayodhāḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सह्यना । पृत्सु । तरणि । न । अर्वा । विआनशिः । रोदसी इति । मेहनावान् ।
> भगः । न । कारे । हव्य । मतीनां । पिताइव । चारुः । सुहवः । वयधाः ॥ ३ ॥

> *sahyanā | pṛtsu | taraṇi | na | arvā | viānaśiḥ | rodasī iti | mehanāvān |*
> *bhagaḥ | na | kāre | havya | matīnāṃ | pitāiva | cāruḥ | suhavaḥ | vayadhāḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> य इंद्रः सहपा बलवान्पृत्सु संग्रामेषु तरणिः । शत्रूनुत्तीर्य वर्तत इति तरणिः । तत्र दृष्टांतः । अर्वा न । यथार्वा बलवानश्वः शत्रुबलं तरति तथा रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यौ व्यानतिर्वा पृत्सुन्मेहनावान् ! मिह्यते सिच्यते दीयतेऽर्थिभ्य इति मेहनं धनं । तद्वान्भवति । तादृश इंद्रः कारे । क्रियत इति कारो यज्ञादिः । तस्मिन्यज्ञे भगो न पूषा देव इव हव्यो हवनीयो मतीनां स्तोत्यणां स्तुतीनां वा पितेव पालयिता चारुः कमनीयः सुहवः सुष्ठाह्वानोपेतो वयोधा अन्नस्य दाता भवति ॥ सहावा । सहोऽस्यास्तीति मतुबर्थे छंदसीवनिपाविति वनिप् । अन्येषामपि दृश्यत इति संहितायां दीर्घः । पृत्सु । पृतनाशब्दस्य सौ परतः मांस्पृत्सूनामुपसंख्यानमिति पृदादेशः । सावेकाच इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । व्यानशिः । अशू व्याप्तावित्यस्माच्छंदसि सदादित्वात्किप्रत्ययः । तस्य लिड्वद्भावः । अत आदेरित्यभ्यासस्य दीर्घे कृतेऽशोतेश्चेति नुडागमः । प्रादिसमासः । कारे । करोतेः कर्मणि घञ् । कर्षात्वतो घञ्नोंत उदात्त इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं । हव्यः । जुहोतेरचो

> यत् । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं । सुहवः । हैयतेर्भानेनुपसर्गस्य । पा–
> ३–३–७५ । इत्यप्प्रत्ययः । संप्रसारणं । प्रत्ययस्य पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ।
> आद्युदात्तं द्व्यच्छंदसीति बहुह्रावुत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *ya iṃdraḥ sahapā balavānpṛtsu saṃgrāmeṣu taraṇiḥ | śatrūnuttīrya vartata*
> *iti taraṇiḥ | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | arvā na | yathārvā balavānaśvaḥ śatrubalaṃ tarati tathā*
> *rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyau vyānatirvā pṛtsunmehanāvān ! mihyate sicyate dīyate 'rthibhya*
> *iti mehanaṃ dhanaṃ | tadvānbhavati | tādṛśa iṃdraḥ kāre | kriyata iti kāro yajñādiḥ |*
> *tasminyajñè bhago na pūṣā deva iva havyo havanīyo matīnāṃ stotyaṇāṃ stutīnāṃ*
> *vā piteva pālayitā cāruḥ kamanīyaḥ suhavaḥ suṣṭhāhvānopeto vayodhā annasya dātā bhavati ‖ sahāvā | saho 'syāstīti matubarthe chaṃdasīvanipāviti vanip |*
> *anyeṣāmapi dṛśyata iti saṃhitāyāṃ dīrghaḥ | pṛtsu | pṛtanāśabdasya sau parataḥ māṃspṛtsūnāmupasaṃkhyānamiti pṛdādeśaḥ | sāvekāca iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | vyānaśiḥ |*
> *aśū vyāptāvityasmācchaṃdasi sadāditvāktipratyayaḥ | tasya liḍvadbhāvaḥ | ata ādirityabhyāsasya dīrghe kṛte 'śoteśveti nuḍāgamaḥ | prādisamāsaḥ | kāre | karoteḥ karmaṇi*
> *ghañ | karṣātvato ghañnoṃta udātta ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | havyaḥ | juhoteraco*
> *yat | yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ | suhavaḥ | haiyaterbhānenupasargasya | pā-*
> *3-3-75 | ityappratyayaḥ | saṃprasāraṇaṃ | pratyayasya pitvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ |*
> *ādyudāttaṃ dvyacchaṃdasīti bahuhrāvuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

That Indra is mighty, and in the pṛtanās, the battles, he is तरणिः (*taraṇiḥ*): he moves on having crossed over his enemies. The illustration is अर्वा न (*arvā na*): as a strong horse crosses the force of the enemy, so he pervades (व्यानशिः (*vyānaśiḥ*)) heaven and earth, the two रोदसी (*rodasī*). He is मेहनावान् (*mehanāvān*): mehana is wealth, which is poured out and given to those who ask, and he possesses it. Such an Indra, in the कारे (*kāre*), that is the sacrifice and the like (what is done, kriyate), is like Bhaga, the god Pūṣan, to be invoked (हव्यः (*havyaḥ*)); he is the protector of the praisers or of the praises (मतीनां (*matīnāṃ*)), like a father; lovely (चारुः (*cāruḥ*)); possessed of a good invocation (सुहवः (*suhavaḥ*)); and giver of food (वयोधा (*vayodhā*)).[?50]

Word-to-word meaning

- सहावा (*sahāvā*)—Indra, endowed with might
- अर्वा न (*arvā na*)—like a swiftly running horse
- पृत्सु (*pṛtsu*)—in battles
- तरणिः (*taraṇiḥ*)—crossing over the enemy armies
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth
- व्यानशिः (*vyānaśiḥ*)—pervading
- मेहनावान् (*mehanāvān*)—he is the distributor of wealth in the form of rain
- कारे (*kāre*)—in the sacrifice
- भगो न (*bhago na*)—like Bhaga
- हव्यः (*havyaḥ*)—fit to receive the oblation
- मतीनां (*matīnāṃ*)—to the praisers
- पितेव (*piteva*)—like a protector, a father
- चारुः (*cāruḥ*)—of lovely form
- सुहवः (*suhavaḥ*)—possessed of an excellent invocation
- वयोधाः (*vayodhāḥ*)—the giver of food

Gist

Indra, endowed with might, like a swiftly running horse, crosses over the enemy armies in battles, pervades heaven and earth, and distributes wealth in the form of rain. In the sacrifice, like Bhaga

Bhāvārtha (continued)

He is worthy to receive the oblation, a protector of the praisers, of lovely form, one who is invoked with excellent invocation, and a giver of food.

English translation

Vigorous, rushing through (hostile), like a warhorse, he has pervaded heaven and earth, sending down rain : he is to be worshipped with oblations at the solemn (rite) like Bhaga : he is as the father of those who adore (him); he is beautiful, worthy of invocation, the bestower of food.

Special Topics

- सहावा (*sahāvā*)—The word सहः (*sahaḥ*) is read among the names for strength (Ni. 3-9). The meaning is "one who has strength".
- तरणिः (*taraṇiḥ*)—शत्रूनुत्तीर्य वर्तत इति तरणिः । (*śatrūnuttīrya vartata iti taraṇiḥ* |) Because he overcomes the enemies, that is, defeats them and stays steadfast, Indra is called taraṇi.
- मेहनावान् (*mehanāvān*)—मिह सेचने । (*miha secane* |) मिह्यते सिच्यते दीयतेऽर्थिभ्य इति मेहनं धनं तद्वान् । (*mihyate sicyate dīyate 'rthibhya iti mehanaṃ dhanaṃ tadvān* |) What is given to those who ask is wealth. The meaning is "one who possesses such wealth".
- मतीनां (*matīnāṃ*)—The word मति (*mati*) is read among the names for the wise (Ni. 3-19). Here the commentator has explained मतीनां (*matīnāṃ*) as "of the hymns" or "of those who praise".
- कारे (*kāre*)—क्रियत इति कारो यज्ञादिः । (*kriyata iti kāro yajñādiḥ* |) The rite that is done or carried out, that is, the sacrificial rite.
- सुहवः (*suhavaḥ*)—सुष्ठाह्वानोपेतः । (*suṣṭhāhvānopetaḥ* |) One who is invoked well, that is, with faith: one who is called, with mantras, by the priests such as the Hotṛ to come to the sacrificial altar.
- अन्नस्य दाता । (*annasya dātā* |) वयोधाः (*vayodhāḥ*)—The word वयः (*vayaḥ*) is read among the names for food (Ni. 3-9). He bears food, that is, he gives food to those who ask.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ध॒र्ता दि॒वो रज॑सस्पृ॒ष्ट ऊ॒र्ध्वो र॒थो न वा॒युर्वसु॑भिर्नि॒युत्वा॑न् ।
क्ष॒पां व॒स्ता ज॑नि॒ता सूर्य॑स्य॒ विभ॑क्ता भा॒गं धि॒षणे॑व॒ वाज॑म् ॥ ४ ॥

> *dhartā divo rajasaspṛṣṭa ūrdhvo ratho na vāyurvasubhirniyutvān |*
> *kṣapāṃ vastā janitā sūryasya vibhaktā bhāgaṃ dhiṣaṇeva vājam ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> धर्ता । दिवः । रजसः । पृष्टः । ऊर्ध्वः । रथः । न । वायुः । वसुभिः । नियुत्वान् ।
> क्षपां । वस्ता । जनिता । सूर्यस्य । विभक्ता । भागं । धिषणा इव । वाजं ॥ ४ ॥

> *dhartā | divaḥ | rajasaḥ | pṛṣṭaḥ | ūrdhvaḥ | rathaḥ | na | vāyuḥ | vasubhiḥ | niyutvān |*
> *kṣapāṃ | vastā | janitā | sūryasya | vibhaktā | bhāgaṃ | dhiṣaṇā iva | vājaṃ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स इंद्रो दिवो द्युलोकस्य रजसोंतरिक्षस्य च धर्ता धारकः पृष्टः सर्वत्र वर्तमानो रथो न तदियो रथ इवोर्धो वायुरूर्ध्वं गंता वसुभिः सहायतया निवसद्भिमरुद्भिर्नियुत्पान्सहायवान् । यद्वा नेत्ययमुत्तरेणापि संबध्यते । यथा वायुर्नियुत्वान्नियुन्नामकवडवाभिस्तद्वानेवमिंद्रो वसुभिर्मरुद्भिः सहायवान् । तथा क्षपां वस्ता रात्रिमाच्छादयनूर्यस्य जगत्पकाशकस्यादित्यस्य जनिता जनयिता भागं भजनीयं वाजं कर्मफलरूपमन्नं विभक्ता साधु विभागकर्ता भवति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । धिषणेव । यथाड्यानां वागस्येदमिति विभागं करोति तद्वत् ॥ रजसः । रंज राग इत्यस्माद्भरंजिभ्यां कित् । उ. ४–२१६ । इत्यसुन् । कित्वान्नलोपः । रज्यते प्रकाशेनेति रजोंतरिक्षं । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । वस्ता । वस आच्छादन इत्यस्य तृचि रूपं । जनिता ! जनयतेस्तृचि जनिता मंत्र इति निपातनाण्णिलोपः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः विभक्ता । भज सेवायामित्यस्य साधुकारिण्यर्थे तृन् । एकाच उपदेश इतीट् प्रतिषेधः । तादौ च निति कृत्यतानिति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं ॥

> *sa iṃdro divo dyulokasya rajasoṃtarikṣasya ca dhartā dhārakaḥ pṛṣṭaḥ sarvatra vartamāno ratho na tadiyo ratha ivordho vāyurūrdhvaṃ gaṃtā vasubhiḥ sahāyatayā nivasadbhimaruddhirniyutpānsahāyavān | yadvā netyayamuttareṇāpi saṃbadhyate | yathā vāyurniyutvānniyunnāmakavaḍavābhistadvānevamiṃdro vasubhirmaruddhiḥ sahāyavān | tathā kṣapāṃ vastā rātrimācchādayanūryasya jagatpakāśakasyādityasya janitā janayitā bhāgaṃ bhajanīyaṃ vājaṃ karmaphalarūpamannaṃ vibhaktā sādhu vibhāgakartā bhavati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | dhiṣaṇeva | yathāḍyānāṃ vāgasyedamiti vibhāgaṃ karoti tadvat ‖ rajasaḥ | raṃja rāga ityasmādbharaṃjibhyāṃ kit | u. 4-216 | ityasun | kitvānnalopaḥ | rajyate prakāśeneti rajoṃtarikṣaṃ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ | vastā | vasa ācchādana ityasya tṛci rūpaṃ | janitā ! janayatestṛci janitā maṃtra iti nipātanāṇṇilopaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ vibhaktā | bhaja sevāyāmityasya sādhukāriṇyarthe tṛn | ekāca upadeśa itīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | tādau ca niti kṛtyatāniti gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ ‖*

Summary

That Indra is the upholder of heaven, the world of light, and of the रजसः (*rajasaḥ*), the atmosphere. पृष्टः (*pṛṣṭaḥ*) means present everywhere. Like his own chariot he is ऊर्ध्वः (*ūrdhvaḥ*), one who goes upward; he is वायुः (*vāyuḥ*), the wind. He is नियुत्वान् (*niyutvān*), possessed of helpers, through the Vasus, the Maruts who dwell with him as helpers. Or else, the word न (*na*) is connected also with what follows: as the wind is नियुत्वान् (*niyutvān*), possessed of the mares called Niyut, so Indra is accompanied by the Vasus, the Maruts. Likewise he covers the night; he is the begetter of the sun, the illuminer of the world; he is the apportioner of the portion, the worshipful food (वाजं (*vājaṃ*)) that is the fruit of rites, a good divider. The example is धिषणेव (*dhiṣaṇeva*): as speech divides among the wealthy, "this is his", so he divides.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of heaven
- रजसः (*rajasaḥ*)—of the atmosphere
- धर्ता (*dhartā*)—the upholder
- पृष्टः (*pṛṣṭaḥ*)—present everywhere
- रथो न (*ratho na*)—like his chariot
- ऊर्ध्वः वायुः (*ūrdhvaḥ vāyuḥ*)—going upward
- वसुभिः (*vasubhiḥ*)—with the Vasus
- नियुत्वान् (*niyutvān*)—joined (with them)
- क्षपां (*kṣapāṃ*)—the night
- वस्ता (*vastā*)—who covers (with darkness)
- सूर्यस्य (*sūryasya*)—of the sun
- जनिता (*janitā*)—the begetter
- धिषणा इव (*dhiṣaṇā iva*)—like the speech that has a rich man's wealth divided
- भागं (*bhāgaṃ*)—worshipful
- वाजं (*vājaṃ*)—food
- विभक्ता (*vibhaktā*)—the divider

Gist

Indra is the upholder of heaven and the atmosphere, present everywhere, going upward like his chariot, joined with the Vasus. He covers the night with darkness, is the begetter of the sun, and divides the worshipful food, like the speech that has a rich man's wealth divided.

English translation

The upholder of heaven and of the firmament, the wind, like a chariot traversing the upper (region) accompanied by the Vasus; the clother of the night (with gloom). the parent of the sun, the distributor of the portion (allotted to the pious), like the words (of the wealthy appropriating to all) the food.

Special Topics

धर्ता दिवो रजसः (*dhartā divo rajasaḥ*)—For the word रजः (*rajaḥ*) Yāska gave the etymology: रजो रजतेर्ज्योती रज उच्यते । (*rajo rajaterjyotī raja ucyate* |) उदकं रज उच्यते । (*udakaṃ raja ucyate* |) लोका रजांस्युच्यंते (*lokā rajāṃsyucyaṃte*) (Ni. 4-19). रज्यते प्रकाशेनेति रजोंतरिक्षं (*rajyate prakāśeneti rajoṃtarikṣaṃ*)—Indra is the regulator of heaven and the atmosphere; that is the meaning.

पृष्टः ऊर्ध्वः रथः न वायुः (*pṛṣṭaḥ ūrdhvaḥ rathaḥ na vāyuḥ*)—Just as Indra's chariot moves everywhere, that is, in all places and in the upper region, so Indra too goes to the worlds above, heaven and the rest. Or, if only the words पृष्टः ऊर्ध्व रथः (*pṛṣṭaḥ ūrdhva rathaḥ*) are explained, the meaning is: he has a chariot able to travel in the upper region, in heaven and so on. In that case the word of comparison न (*na*) has to be joined with the word वायुः (*vāyuḥ*) in explaining. Then:

वायुः न वसुभिः नियुत्वान् (*vāyuḥ na vasubhiḥ niyutvān*)—The sense can be given: Indra, helped by the Marut deities, like the wind that has the vehicle called Niyuta. Or वसुभिर्नियुत्वान्—निवसद्भिमरुद्भिर्नियुत्वान् सहायवान् (*vasubhirniyutvān—nivasadbhimarudbhirniyutvān sahāyavān*)—the meaning can also be given as: one who has obtained help from the Maruts who are always with Indra.

क्षपां (*kṣapāṃ*)—Since the word क्षपा (*kṣapā*) is read among the names of night (Ni. 22-8), क्षपां (*kṣapāṃ*) means the night together with its darkness.

जनिता सूर्यस्य (*janitā sūryasya*)—It has been explained earlier that the sun rises and shines by Indra's power.

विभक्ता भागं धिषणेव वाजं (*vibhaktā bhāgaṃ dhiṣaṇeva vājaṃ*)—यथाड्यानां वागस्येदमिति करोति तद्वत् कर्मफलरूपमन्नं साधु विभागकर्ता भवति । (*yathāḍyānāṃ vāgasyedamiti karoti tadvat karmaphalarūpamannaṃ sādhu vibhāgakartā bhavati* |) The sense of this sentence is: as the wealthy divide, saying "this is for you, this is for him", so Indra distributes food and the like, the fruit in accordance with their rites, to those who have performed sacrifices and other rites.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शु॒नं हु॑वेम म॒घवा॑न॒मिन्द्र॑म॒स्मिन्भ॒रे नृत॑मं॒ वाज॑सातौ
।
शृ॒ण्वन्त॑मु॒ग्रमू॒तये॑ स॒मत्सु॒ घ्नन्तं॑ वृ॒त्राणि॑ सं॒जितं॒ धना॑
नाम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *śunaṃ huvema maghavānamindramasminbhare nṛtamaṃ vājasātau |*
> *śṛṇvantamugramūtaye samatsu ghnantaṃ vṛtrāṇi saṃjitaṃ dhanānām ‖*
> *5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुनं । हुवेम । मघ्नवानं । इंद्रं । अस्मिन् । भरे । नृतमं । वाजसात् ।
> श्रृण्वंतं । उग्रं । ऊतये । समत्सु । घ्नंतं । वृत्राणि । संजितं । धनानां ॥

> *śunaṃ | huvema | maghnavānaṃ | iṃdraṃ | asmin | bhare | nṛtamaṃ | vājasāt |*
> *śṛṇvaṃtaṃ | ugraṃ | ūtaye | samatsu | ghnaṃtaṃ | vṛtrāṇi | saṃjitaṃ | dhanānāṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वाजसात् । वाजस्यान्नस्य सातिर्लाभो यस्मिन् सोऽयं वाजसातिः।
> अस्मिन्भरे । बिभ्रति जयलक्ष्मीमनेन योद्धार इति भरः संग्रामः । तस्मिन् संग्रामे
> शुनं शूनमुत्साहेन प्रवृद्धं । यद्वा शुनमिति सुखनाम । सुखकरं मघवानं
> धनवंतं अत एवेंद्रं निरतिशयैश्वर्यसंपन्नं नृतमं सर्वस्य जगतोऽतिशयेन
> नेतारं त्वां हुवेम । कुशिका वयं यज्ञार्थमाह्वयेम । तथा श्रृण्वंतमस्माभिः
> क्रियमाणां स्तुतिं श्रृण्वंतमुग्रं शत्रूणां भयंकरं समत्तु संग्रामेषु वृत्राणि
> वृत्रोपलक्षितानि सर्वाणि रक्षांसि घ्नंतं हिंसंतं धनानां शत्रुसंबंधिनां संजितं
> सम्यग्जेतारं त्वामूतये रक्षणाय वयमाह्वयेम ॥ शुनं । टुओश्वि गतिवृद्ध्योरित्यस्य निष्ठायां
> यस्य विभाषेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । दीर्घाभावश्च्छांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हुवेम
> । हैयतेर्बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणे कृते
> शपो लुकि कृते च लिजि रूपं । निघातः । भरे । भृञ् भरणे । घः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ।
> वाजसात् । षणु दार् । भावे क्तिन् । जनसनेत्यादिनानुनासिकस्यात्वं ।

> बहुप्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । समत्तु । अद भक्षणे । संपूर्वात् क्विप् । संभक्षयंति
> योद्धृणामायूंषीति समदः संग्रामाः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । घ्नंतं । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य शतरि
> गमहनेत्यादिनोपधालोपः । हो हंतेरिति घत्वं । संजितं ।
> जि जये । क्विप् ॥

> *he iṃdra vājasāt | vājasyānnasya sātirlābho yasmin so 'yaṃ vājasātiḥ|*
> *asminbhare | bibhrati jayalakṣmīmanena yoddhāra iti bharaḥ*
> *saṃgrāmaḥ | tasmin saṃgrāme*
> *śunaṃ śūnamutsāhena pravṛddhaṃ | yadvā śunamiti sukhanāma |*
> *sukhakaraṃ maghavānaṃ*
> *dhanavaṃtaṃ ata eveṃdraṃ niratiśayaiśvaryasaṃpannaṃ nṛtamaṃ*
> *sarvasya jagato 'tiśayena*
> *netāraṃ tvāṃ huvema | kuśikā vayaṃ yajñārthamāhvayema | tathā*
> *śṛṇvaṃtamasmābhiḥ*
> *kriyamāṇāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇvaṃtamugraṃ śatrūṇāṃ bhayaṃkaraṃ samattu*
> *saṃgrāmeṣu vṛtrāṇi*
> *vṛtropalakṣitāni sarvāṇi rakṣāṃsi ghnaṃtaṃ hiṃsaṃtaṃ dhanānāṃ*
> *śatrusaṃbaṃdhināṃ saṃjitaṃ*
> *samyagjetāraṃ tvāmūtaye rakṣaṇāya vayamāhvayema ‖ śunaṃ | ṭuośvi*
> *gativṛddhyorityasya niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya vibhāṣetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ |*
> *yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *huvema | haiyaterbahulaṃ chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe kṛte*
> *śapo luki kṛte ca liji rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | bhare | bhṛñ bharaṇe | ghaḥ |*
> *vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ | vājasāt | ṣaṇu dār | bhāve ktin |*
> *janasanetyādinānunāsikasyātvaṃ |*
> *bahuprīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | samattu | ada bhakṣaṇe | saṃpūrvāt*
> *kvip | saṃbhakṣayaṃti*
> *yoddhṛṇāmāyūṃṣīti samadaḥ saṃgrāmāḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ |*
> *ghnaṃtaṃ | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya śatari*
> *gamahanetyādinopadhālopaḥ | ho haṃteriti ghatvaṃ | saṃjitaṃ |*
> *ji jaye | kvip ‖*

Summary

O Indra, वाजसात् (*vājasāt*): he in whom there is the winning (सातिः (*sātiḥ*)) of food (वाज (*vāja*)), is वाजसातिः (*vājasātiḥ*). भरे (*bhare*): because by it the warriors bear the fortune of victory, भरः (*bharaḥ*) is battle; in this battle. शुनं (*śunaṃ*) means swollen, grown by zeal; or else शुनं

(*śunaṃ*) is a name for happiness, so "giver of happiness". मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*) is the wealthy one, and therefore इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*), endowed with unsurpassed lordship; नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*), the supreme leader of the whole world: you we, the Kuśikas, invoke for the sacrifice. Likewise, hearing the praise made by us, शृण्वंतं (*śṛṇvaṃtaṃ*); उग्रं (*ugraṃ*), terrible to the enemies; समत्सु (*samatsu*), in battles, slaying all the demons denoted by Vṛtra (वृत्राणि (*vṛtrāṇi*)); संजितं (*saṃjitaṃ*), the full conqueror of the enemies' wealth: you we invoke for protection (ऊतये (*ūtaye*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)—proceeding for the sake of food
- भरे (*bhare*)—in the battle
- शुनं (*śunaṃ*)—one who grows through zeal, or who produces happiness
- मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)—wealthy
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—endowed with unsurpassed lordship
- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—who is the leader
- (you) हुवेम (*huvema*)—we call, praying
- शृण्वंतं (*śṛṇvaṃtaṃ*)—who listens (to our praises)
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—who is terrible to enemies
- समत्सु (*samatsu*)—in battles
- वृत्राणि (*vṛtrāṇi*)—the demons beginning with Vṛtra
- घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)—who destroys, slaying
- धनानां (*dhanānāṃ*)—the wealth (of the enemies)
- संजितं (*saṃjitaṃ*)—who gathers (for us)
- ऊतये (*ūtaye*)—for protection

Gist

O Indra, in the battle that is fought for the sake of food, you who give happiness, are wealthy, endowed with unsurpassed lordship, a leader, who listen to our praises, are terrible to enemies, slay and destroy the demons beginning with Vṛtra in battles, and gather the enemies' wealth for us—you we call, praying, for protection.

English translation

We invoke for our protection the opulent Indra, distinguished in this combat, the leader in the food-bestowing (strife), hearing (our praises), terri- ble in battles, the destroyer of foes, the conqueror of wealth.

Special Topics

The special topics of this ṛk have been explained earlier. This is the fiftieth sūkta.[?51]

Sūkta 50 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इंद्रः स्वाहेति पंचर्चं द्वादशं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभमैंद्रं ॥ दशरात्रॆ नवमेऽहनि मरुत्वतीयशस्त्र इदं
> सूक्तं । सूत्रितं च । तृतीयस्येंद्रः स्वाहा
> गायत्साम । आ. ८–७ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु—इंद्रः स्वाहा ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हन्नॆरडनॆय
> सूक्तवु. इदरल्लि ऐदु ऋक्कुगळिरुवुवु ई सूक्तक्कॆ विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु ; इंद्रनु दॆवतॆयु
> त्रिष्टुप्छंदस्सु. दशरात्रवॆंब यागद ऒंभत्तनॆय दिनदल्लि मरुत्वतीयशस्त्रमंत्रगळन्नु पठिसुवाग
> ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद–तृतीयस्येंद्रः स्वाहा गायत्साम
> ऎंब सूत्रदिंद विवृतवागिरुवुदु. (अ. ८–७)

> *iṃdraḥ svāheti paṃcarcaṃ dvādaśaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ*
> *traiṣṭubhamaiṃdraṃ ‖ daśarātrè navame 'hani marutvatīyaśastra idaṃ*
> *sūktaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | tṛtīyasyeṃdraḥ svāhā*
> *gāyatsāma | ā. 8-7 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—iṃdraḥ svāhā èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli hannèraḍanèya*
> *sūktavu. idaralli aidu ṛkkugaḷiruvuvu ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu ; iṃdranu devatèyu*
> *triṣṭupchaṃdassu. daśarātravèṃba yāgada òṃbhattanèya dinadalli marutvatīyaśastramaṃtragaḷannu paṭhisuvāga*
> *ī sūktada viniyogaviruvudèṃdu āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada-tṛtīyasyeṃdraḥ svāhā gāyatsāma*
> *èṃba sūtradiṃda vivṛtavāgiruvudu. (a. 8-7)*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The twelfth sūkta, इंद्रः स्वाहा (*iṃdraḥ svāhā*), of five ṛks, is by Viśvāmitra, in the triṣṭubh metre, addressed to Indra. On the ninth day of the Daśarātra this sūkta is used in the Marutvatīya Śastra. The Sūtra says: तृतीयस्येंद्रः स्वाहा गायत्साम (*tṛtīyasyeṃdraḥ svāhā gāyatsāma*) (Ā. 8-7). The Kannada Anuvāda repeats this: the sūkta is the twelfth in the fourth anuvāka, with five ṛks, seer Viśvāmitra, deity Indra, metre Triṣṭubh, used when the Marutvatīya Śastra mantras are recited on the ninth day of the Daśarātra sacrifice, as set out by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra.

> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—५०
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—५० ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—१४ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—५ ॥
> । ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ।
> । देवता—इंद्रः ।
> । छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ।
> संहितापारकि

> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—50*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—50 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—14 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—5 ‖*
> *| ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ |*
> *| devatā—iṃdraḥ |*
> *| chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup |*
> *saṃhitāpāraki*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒◌ः स्वाहा॑ पिबतु॒ यस्य॒ सोम॑ आ॒गत्या॒ तुम्रो॑ वृ
ष॒भो म॒रुत्वा॑न् ।
ओरु॒व्यचा॑◌ः पृणतामे॒भिरन्नै॒रास्य॑ ह॒विस्त॒न्व१॒॑◌ः काम॑
मृध्याः ॥ १ ॥

> *indraḥ svāhā pibatu yasya soma āgatyā tumro vṛṣabho marutvān |*
> *oruvyacāḥ pṛṇatāmebhirannairāsya havistanvaḥ kāmamṛdhyāḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रः । स्वाहा । पिबतु । यस्य । सोमः । आगत्य । तुम्रः । वृषभः । मरुत्वान् ।
> आ । उरुव्यचाः । पृणतां । एभिः । अन्नैः । आ । अस्य । हविः । तन्नः । कामं । यध्याः॥

> *iṃdraḥ | svāhā | pibatu | yasya | somaḥ | āgatya | tumraḥ | vṛṣabhaḥ | marutvān |*
> *ā | uruvyacāḥ | pṛṇatāṃ | ebhiḥ | annaiḥ | ā | asya | haviḥ | tannaḥ | kāmaṃ | yadhyāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अयमिंद्रः स्वाहा स्वाहाकृतमिमं सोमं पिबतु । यस्येंद्रस्यायं सोमः
> स इंद्रो यज्ञं प्रत्यागत्य तुम्रः कर्मविघ्नकारिणां हिंसको वृषभो यष्टणामभिमतफलवर्षको
> मरुत्वान्मरुद्भिस्तद्वान् उरुव्यचाः प्रभूतव्याप्तिः सन् एभिरस्माभिर्दत्तैरन्नैः
> सोमादिलक्षणैर्हविर्भिरा पृणतां । समंतात्पूरयतु । ततोऽस्येंद्रस्य संबंधिनस्तन्वः शरीरस्य
> कामं पुष्पादिलक्षणविषयमभिलाषं हविरस्माभिर्दत्तमा ऋध्याः । सर्वतः पूरयतु ॥ तुम्रः ।
> तुमिराहननार्थः । उरुव्यचाः ।
> व्यचेरसुन् । व्यचेः कुटादित्वमनसीति वक्तव्यमित्यत्रानसीति पर्युदासात् जिताभावः ।
> कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । ऋध्याः । ऋध्योतेराशीर्लिंजि रूपं ॥

> *ayamiṃdraḥ svāhā svāhākṛtamimaṃ somaṃ pibatu | yasyeṃdrasyāyaṃ somaḥ*
> *sa iṃdro yajñaṃ pratyāgatya tumraḥ karmavighnakāriṇāṃ hiṃsako vṛṣabho yaṣṭaṇāmabhimataphalavarṣako marutvānmaruddhistadvān uruvyacāḥ prabhūtavyāptiḥ san ebhirasmābhirdattairannaiḥ somādilakṣaṇairhavirbhirā pṛṇatāṃ | samaṃtātpūrayatu | tato 'syeṃdrasya saṃbaṃdhinastanvaḥ śarīrasya kāmaṃ puṣpādilakṣaṇaviṣayamabhilāṣaṃ havirasmābhirdattamā ṛdhyāḥ | sarvataḥ pūrayatu ‖ tumraḥ | tumirāhananārthaḥ | uruvyacāḥ |*
> *vyacerasun | vyaceḥ kuṭāditvamanasīti vaktavyamityatrānasīti paryudāsāt jitābhāvaḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | ṛdhyāḥ | ṛdhyoterāśīrlija rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

May this Indra drink this soma offered with स्वाहा (*svāhā*) (the svāhā-call). The Indra whose soma this is, having come to the sacrifice, is तुम्रः (*tumraḥ*), the destroyer of those who obstruct the rite; वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*), the one who showers the desired fruit on the sacrificers;

मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*), accompanied by the Maruts; उरुव्यचाः (*uruvyacāḥ*), of wide extent. Let him fill himself fully with these foods given by us, the oblations beginning with soma. Then let him fulfil on all sides the desire of this Indra's body, whose object is flowers and the like, the oblation given by us.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- स्वाहा (*svāhā*)—the Soma offered with the cry svāhā
- पिबतु (*pibatu*)—may he drink
- सोमः (*somaḥ*)—this Soma
- यस्य (*yasya*)—for which Indra it is intended, that Indra
- अगत्य (*agatya*)—having come to the sacrifice[?52]
- तुम्रः (*tumraḥ*)—the destroyer (of those who cause obstacles to the sacrifice)[?53]
- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—the showerer of desired fruit upon the sacrificers
- मरुत्वान् (*marutvān*)—accompanied by the Maruts
- उरुव्यजाः (*uruvyajāḥ*)—widely pervading
- विभिः (*vibhiḥ*)—by these, given by us[?54]
- अन्नैः (*annaiḥ*)—with oblations in the form of Soma
- आ पृणतां (*ā pṛṇatāṃ*)—may he attain full satisfaction
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Indra
- तन्नः (*tannaḥ*)—to the body[?55]
- कामं (*kāmaṃ*)—nourishment
- हविः (*haviḥ*)—(this) oblation (given by us)
- आ ऋध्याः (*ā ṛdhyāḥ*)—may it fully bring about

Gist

May Indra drink the Soma offered with the cry svāhā. The Indra for whom this Soma is intended, having come to the sacrifice, being a destroyer of those who cause obstacles to the sacrifice, a showerer of desired fruit, accompanied by the Maruts and widely pervading, may attain full satisfaction with these Soma-oblations given by us. May this oblation given by us bring full nourishment to Indra's body.

English translation

May Indra drink the libation ; he of whom is the Soma, having come to the sacrifice ; he who is the repeller (of adversaries), the showerer (of benefits), the lord of the Maruts ; may he, the wide-pervading, be pleased with these (sacrificial) viands ; may the oblation be adequate to the wants of his body.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ ते॑ सप॒र्यू ज॒वसे॑ युनज्मि॒ ययो॒रनु॑ प्र॒दिव॑ः श्रु॒ष्टिमाव॑ः ।
इ॒ह त्वा॑ धेयु॒र्हर॑यः सुशि॒प्र पिबा॒ त्व१॒॑स्य सुषु॑तस्य॒ चारो॑ः ॥ २ ॥

> *ā te saparyū javase yunajmi yayoranu pradivaḥ śruṣṭimāvaḥ |*
> *iha tvā dheyurharayaḥ suśipra pibā tvasya suṣutasya cāroḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । ते । सपर्यू इति । जवसे । युनज्मि । ययोः । अनु । प्रदिवः । श्रुष्टिं । आवः।
> इह । त्वा । धेयुः । हरयः । सुशिप्र । पिब । तु । अस्य । सुसुतस्य । चारोः ॥ २ ॥

> *ā | te | saparyū iti | javase | yunajmi | yayoḥ | anu | pradivaḥ | śruṣṭiṃ | āvaḥ|*
> *iha | tvā | dheyuḥ | harayaḥ | suśipra | piba | tu | asya | susutasya | cāroḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र ते तव जवसे यज्ञं प्रत्यागमनाय सपर्यू परिचारकौ ९ री आ
> युनज्मे । रथे योजयामि । प्रदिवः पुरातनस्त्वं ययोरश्वयोः श्रुष्टिं वेगं ।
> श्रुष्टीति क्षिप्रनामेति यास्कः । तमन्वावः । अनुगच्छसि । हे सुशिप्र शोभनहनो इंद्र
> हरयो रथे योजतास्तेऽश्वा इह कर्मणि त्वां त्वां धेयुः । यज्ञं प्रति धारयंतु । तत आगतस्त्वं
> सुषुतस्य सुष्वभिषुतं चारोः कमनीयमस्येमं सोमं
> तु क्षिप्रं पिब ॥ सपर्यू । सपरशब्दः कंड्वादिः । तदंतादौणादिकः कुप्रत्ययः । आवः।

> अव रक्षणादिषु । छांदसे लजि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । धेयुः । दधातेराशीर्लिंजि
> किदाशिषीति यासुट् । एर्लिंजि । पा. ६–४–६७ । इत्येकारादेशः । निघातः ।
> पिब । पादादित्पादनिघातः । सुषुतस्य । सुञ् अभिषवे । कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति
> गतिस्वरः । उपसर्गात्सुनोतीत्यादिना संहितायां षत्वं ॥

> *he iṃdra te tava javase yajñaṃ pratyāgamanāya saparyū paricārakau 9*
> *rī ā*
> *yunajmè | rathe yojayāmi | pradivaḥ purātanastvaṃ yayoraśvayoḥ*
> *śruṣṭiṃ vegaṃ |*
> *śruṣṭīti kṣipranāmeti yāskaḥ | tamanvāvaḥ | anugacchasi | he suśipra*
> *śobhanahano iṃdra*
> *harayo rathe yojatāste 'śvā iha karmaṇi tvāṃ tvāṃ dheyuḥ | yajñaṃ*
> *prati dhārayaṃtu | tata āgatastvaṃ suṣutasya suṣvabhiṣutaṃ cāroḥ*
> *kamanīyamasyèmaṃ somaṃ*
> *tu kṣipraṃ piba ‖ saparyū | saparaśabdaḥ kaṃḍvādiḥ |*
> *tadaṃtādauṇādikaḥ kupratyayaḥ | āvaḥ|*
> *ava rakṣaṇādiṣu | chāṃdase laji rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *dheyuḥ | dadhāterāśīrliji kidāśiṣīti yāsuṭ | erliji | pā. 6-4-67 |*
> *ityekārādeśaḥ | nighātaḥ |*
> *piba | pādāditpādanighātaḥ | suṣutasya | suñ abhiṣave | karmaṇi ktaḥ |*
> *gatiranaṃtara iti*
> *gatisvaraḥ | upasargātsunotītyādinā saṃhitāyāṃ ṣatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, for your speed, that is, for your coming to the sacrifice, I yoke to the chariot the two attendants (the two horses)." You, the ancient one, follow the speed (श्रुष्टिं (*śruṣṭiṃ*)) of which two horses; Yāska says "श्रुष्टीति क्षिप्रनामेति (*śruṣṭīti kṣipranāmeti*)" (śruṣṭi is a name for "quick"), and you go along with that speed. O Sushipra, Indra of fair jaws, may the bay horses yoked to the chariot bear you here in this rite, may they hold you toward the sacrifice. Having come thence, quickly drink this well-pressed, lovely Soma.

Word-to-word meaning

- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—(O Indra) you, the ancient one
- ययोः (*yayoḥ*)—of which horses
- श्रुष्टिं (*śruṣṭiṃ*)—the speed

- आनु आवः (*ānu āvaḥ*)—you follow, of such
- सपर्यू (*saparyū*)—the horses that serve you
- ते (*te*)—your
- जवसे (*javase*)—for swift going (to come to the sacrifice)
- आ युनज्मि (*ā yunajmi*)—I join and bind to the chariot
- सुशिप्र (*suśipra*)—O Indra of excellent cheeks
- हरयः (*harayaḥ*)—your horses
- इह (*iha*)—in this rite
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- धेयुः (*dheyuḥ*)—may they bear and bring
- सुष्टुतस्य (*suṣṭutasya*)—of what is excellently pressed[?56]
- चारोः (*cāroḥ*)—and lovely
- अस्य (*asya*)—this Soma
- तु (*tu*)—quickly
- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, you, the ancient one, follow the speed of certain horses; I join to your chariot those horses that serve you, so that they bring you quickly to this sacrifice. O Indra of excellent cheeks, may your horses bear you here in this rite. Drink quickly this Soma, well pressed and lovely.

English translation

I yoke (to your car), to bring you quickly, your two docile horses, whose speed you have of old employed : may your horses, handsome Indra, bring you hither, and drink promptly of this well-effused agreeable libation.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

गोभि॑र्मिमि॒क्षुं द॑धिरे सुपा॒रमिन्द्रं॒ ज्यैष्ठ्या॑य॒ धाय॑से गृणा॒नाः ।
म॒न्दा॒नः सोमं॑ पपि॒वाँ ऋ॑जीषि॒न्सम॒स्मभ्यं॑ पुरु॒धा गा इ॑षण्य ॥ ३ ॥

> *gobhirmimikṣuṃ dadhire supāramindraṃ jyaiṣṭhyāya dhāyase gṛṇānāḥ |*
> *mandānaḥ somaṃ papivā~ ṛjīṣinsamasmabhyaṃ purudhā gā iṣaṇya ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गोभिः । मिमिक्षुं । दधिरे । सुपारं । इंद्रं ज्यैष्ठाय । धायसे । गृणानाः ।
> मंदानः । सोमं । पपिवान् । ऋजीषिन् । सं । अस्मभ्यं । पुरुधा । गाः । इषण्य ॥

> *gobhiḥ | mimikṣuṃ | dadhire | supāraṃ | iṃdraṃ jyaiṣṭhāya | dhāyase | gṛṇānāḥ |*
> *maṃdānaḥ | somaṃ | papivān | ṛjīṣin | saṃ | asmabhyaṃ | purudhā | gāḥ | iṣaṇya ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> गृणानाः स्तोत्रं कुर्वाणा ऋत्विजो मिमिक्षुं स्तोतृणामभिमतफलं
> वर्षितुमिच्छंतं सुपारं शोभनपारं स्तुतिभिरभिमुखीकर्तुं शक्यमित्यर्थः । तादृशमिंद्रं ज्यैष्ठाय
> धनादिसंपत्ता श्रेष्ठत्वाय धायसे चिरकालमायुर्धारणाय
> च गोभिर्गोमिश्रितैः सोमैर्दधिरे । धारयंति । शेषः प्रत्यक्षः । हे ऋजेषिन्
> सोमवन्निंद्र स त्वं मंदानो मोदमानः सोमं पपिवान् सोमस्य पाता सन्
> स्तोतृभ्योऽस्मभ्यं पुरुधा बहुधा गा अग्निहोत्रादिकर्मसिद्ध्यर्थं धेनूः समिषण्य।
> सम्यक् प्रेरय ॥ गोभिः । सावेकाच इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वे प्राप्ते न गोश्वन्नाववर्णेति प्रतिषेधः ।
> मिमिक्षुं। मिह सेचन इत्यस्य सन्येकाच इतीट् प्रतिषेधे हलंताच्चेति किद्वद्भावः । सनाशंसभिक्ष
> उः । प्रय्ययस्वरः । ज्यैष्ठाय । ज्येष्ठस्य भाव
> इत्यर्थे ब्राह्मणादित्वात् प्यञ् । इत्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । गृणानाः । ग्य शब्दे । क्रादित्वात् श्ना ।
> चित्वादंतोदात्तः । मंदानः । मदि स्तुत्यादिष्टित्यस्य शानचि बहुलं

> *gṛṇānāḥ stotraṃ kurvāṇā ṛtvijo mimikṣuṃ stotṛṇāmabhimataphalaṃ*
> *varṣitumicchaṃtaṃ supāraṃ śobhanapāraṃ stutibhirabhimukhīkartuṃ*
> *śakyamityarthaḥ | tādṛśamiṃdraṃ jyaiṣṭhāya dhanādisaṃpattā*
> *śreṣṭhatvāya dhāyase cirakālamāyurdhāraṇāya*
> *ca gobhirgòmiśritaiḥ somairdadhire | dhārayaṃti | śeṣaḥ pratyakṣaḥ |*
> *he ṛjeṣin*
> *somavanniṃdra sa tvaṃ maṃdāno modamānaḥ somaṃ papivān*
> *somasya pātā san*
> *stotṛbhyo 'smabhyaṃ purudhā bahudhā gā*
> *agnihotrādikarmasiddhyarthaṃ dhenūḥ samiṣaṇya|*
> *samyak preraya ‖ gobhiḥ | sāvekāca iti vibhakterudāttatve prāpte na*
> *gośvannāvavarṇèti pratiṣedhaḥ | mimikṣuṃ| miha secana ityasya*
> *sanyekāca itīṭ pratiṣedhe halaṃtācceti kidvadbhāvaḥ | sanāśaṃsabhikṣa*
> *uḥ | prayyayasvaraḥ | jyaiṣṭhāya | jyeṣṭhasya bhāva*
> *ityarthe brāhmaṇāditvāt pyañ | ittvādādyudāttaḥ | gṛṇānāḥ | gya śabde*
> *| krāditvāt śnā | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | maṃdānaḥ | madi*
> *stutyādiṣṭityasya śānaci bahulaṃ*

> छंदसीति शपो लुक् । पुरुधा । पुरुष शब्द इह संख्यावाची । संख्याया विधार्थे
> धेति धाप्रत्ययः । इषण्य । इष गतौ । इषणमिच्छतीति छंदसि परेच्छायां क्यच्
> तदंतादंतर्भावितण्यर्थल्लोटि रूपं ॥

> *chaṃdasīti śapo luk | purudhā | puruṣa śabda iha saṃkhyāvācī |*
> *saṃkhyāyā vidhārthe*
> *dheti dhāpratyayaḥ | iṣaṇya | iṣa gatau | iṣaṇamicchatīti chaṃdasi*
> *parecchāyāṃ kyac*
> *tadaṃtādaṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthalloṭi rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

The priests, praising, hold (offer) Soma mixed with milk (गोभिः (*gobhiḥ*), with cows' products) to that Indra who wishes to shower on the praisers their desired fruit and who is सुपारं (*supāraṃ*), one of good passage, that is, one who can easily be turned toward them by praises. They do so for excellence (ज्यैष्ठाय (*jyaiṣṭhāya*)) in wealth and other prosperity and for holding long life (धायसे (*dhāyase*)); the remainder of the verse is plain. O Indra, rich in Soma (ऋजेषिन्

(*ṛjeṣin*)), you, rejoicing and having drunk the Soma, send forth to us, the praisers, many (पुरुधा (*purudhā*)) cows, milch cattle, for the accomplishment of rites such as the Agnihotra; send them well.

Gist (continued): The remainder is grammatical only; it notes that पुरुधा (*purudhā*) is formed from a numeral-word with the affix meaning "in so many ways", and that इषण्य (*iṣaṇya*) is an imperative form from the root इष (*iṣa*).

Word-to-word meaning

- गृणानाः (*gṛṇānāḥ*)—the priests, the praisers
- मिमिक्षुं (*mimikṣuṃ*)—who wishes to shower the desired fruit
- सुपारं (*supāraṃ*)—who can be turned toward them by praise
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- ज्येष्ठाय (*jyeṣṭhāya*)—for excellent wealth and other prosperity[?57]
- धायसे (*dhāyase*)—for obtaining long life
- गोभिः (*gobhiḥ*)—with Soma mixed with milk
- दधिरे (*dadhire*)—they hold (vessels filled)
- यजीषिन् (*yajīṣin*)—O Indra, possessor of Soma[?58]
- मंदानः (*maṃdānaḥ*)—rejoicing
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- पपिवान् (*papivān*)—drinking
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—to us, the praisers
- पुरुधा (*purudhā*)—in great abundance
- गाः (*gāḥ*)—the milch cows that furnish means for the sacrifice
- सं इषण्य (*saṃ iṣaṇya*)—furnish and give

Gist

The praising priests hold vessels filled with Soma mixed with milk toward Indra, who wishes to shower the desired fruit and can be turned toward them by praise, for excellent wealth and other prosperity and for obtaining long life. O Indra, rich in Soma, rejoicing and drinking the Soma, furnish to us, the praisers, in great abundance the cows useful for the sacrifice.

English translation

His adorers support with cattle, Indra, who is willing to bestow upon them their desires, and ready to come to the sacrifice, for the sake of obtaining eminent prosperity and prolonged life : acceptor of the spiritless Soma, who are the drinker of the Soma juice, and are exhilarated (by the draught), grant to us freely cattle in abundance.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मं कामं॑ मन्दया॒ गोभि॒रश्वै॑श्च॒न्द्रव॑ता॒ राध॑सा प॒प्रथ॑श्च ।
स्व॒र्यवो॑ म॒तिभि॒स्तुभ्यं॒ विप्रा॒ इन्द्रा॑य॒ वाह॑ः कुशि॒कासो॑ अक्रन् ॥ ४ ॥

> *imaṃ kāmaṃ mandayā gobhiraśvaiścandravatā rādhasā paprathaśca |*
> *svaryavo matibhistubhyaṃ viprā indrāya vāhaḥ kuśikāso akran ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमं । कामं । मंदय । गोभिः । अश्वैः । चंद्रवता । राधसा । पप्रथः । च ।
> स्वःयवः । मतिभिः । तुभ्यं । विप्राः । इंद्राय । वाहः । कुशिकासः । अक्रन् ॥ ४ ॥

> *imaṃ | kāmaṃ | maṃdaya | gobhiḥ | aśvaiḥ | caṃdravatā | rādhasā | paprathaḥ | ca |*
> *svaḥyavaḥ | matibhiḥ | tubhyaṃ | viprāḥ | iṃdrāya | vāhaḥ | kuśikāsaḥ | akran ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र इम धनादिविषयं काममस्मदीयमभिलाषं गोभिरग्निहोत्राडिकर्मसाधनभूतैर्गवादिभिर्वाहनसाधनभूतैरश्वैश्च चंद्रवता दीप्तियुक्तेन राधसा धनेन च मंदय । एतानि दत्तेममभिलाषं पूरय । किंच । एतैरस्मान्पप्रथः । प्रथितांश्च कुरु । पश्चात्स्यर्यवः स्वर्गादिसुखमात्मन इच्छंतो विप्राः कर्मकुशलाः कुशिकासः कुशिका मतिभिर्मननीयैर्मंत्रैर्वाहः स्तोत्रमिंद्राय तुभ्यमक्रन् । अकार्षुः ॥ मंदय । मदि स्तुत्यादिष्वित्यस्य लोटि रूपं । गोभिः । सावेकाच इति

> विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वे प्राप्ते न गोश्वन्सावववर्णेत्यादिना प्रतिषेधः । प्रकृतिस्वरः । पप्रथः ।
> प्रथ प्रख्याने । क्विप् । छंदस्युभयथेति तस्य सार्वधातुकत्वात् शप् । तस्य बहुलं
> छंदसीति श्लुः । धातुस्वरः । अक्रन् । करोतेर्लुजि मंत्रे घसह्वरेत्यादिना लुक् ।
> निघातः ॥

> *he iṃdra ima dhanādiviṣayaṃ kāmamasmadīyamabhilāṣaṃ gobhiragni hotrāḍikarmasādhanabhūtairgavādibhirvāhanasādhanabhūtairaśvaiśca caṃdravatā dīptiyuktena rādhasā*
> *dhanena ca maṃdaya | etāni dattemamabhilāṣaṃ pūraya | kiṃca | etairasmānpaprathaḥ |*
> *prathitāṃśca kuru | paścātsyaryavaḥ svargādisukhamātmana icchaṃto viprāḥ karmakuśalāḥ*
> *kuśikāsaḥ kuśikā matibhirmananīyairmaṃtrairvāhaḥ stotramiṃdrāya tubhyamakran |*
> *akārṣuḥ ‖ maṃdaya | madi stutyādiṣṭhityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | gobhiḥ | sāvekāca iti*
> *vibhakterudāttatve prāpte na gośvansāvavarṇetyādinā pratiṣedhaḥ | prakṛtisvaraḥ | paprathaḥ |*
> *pratha prakhyāne | kvip | chaṃdasyubhayatheti tasya sārvadhātukatvāt śap | tasya bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti śluḥ | dhātusvaraḥ | akran | karoterluji maṃtre ghasahvaretyādinā luk |*
> *nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, gratify (मंदय (*maṃdaya*)) this desire of ours, concerning wealth and the like, with cows that are the means for rites such as the Agnihotra, with horses that are the means of conveyance, and with shining wealth (राधसा (*rādhasā*)). Give these and fulfil this desire. Further, make us extended, that is, renowned, by these. Afterwards the Kuśikas, wise (विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)), skilled in rites, desiring heaven and similar happiness for themselves, have made (अक्रन् (*akran*), "have done") praise for you, Indra, with thoughtful (मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)) mantras.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra

- इमं कामं (*imaṃ kāmaṃ*)—this desire of ours concerning wealth
- गोभिः (*gobhiḥ*)—by furnishing cows
- अश्वैः (*aśvaiḥ*)—and by horses
- चंद्रवता (*caṃdravatā*)—shining
- राधसा (*rādhasā*)—and by wealth
- मंदय (*maṃdaya*)—satisfy
- पप्रथः (*paprathaḥ*)—make (us) renowned
- स्वरवः (*svaravaḥ*)—those who desire the happiness of heaven and the like[?59]
- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—skilled in rites
- कुशिकासः (*kuśikāsaḥ*)—the sages born of the Kuśika family
- मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)—with words in the form of mantras
- वाहः (*vāhaḥ*)—praise
- इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)—for you, Indra
- अक्रन् (*akran*)—they have made

Gist

O Indra, satisfy this desire of ours concerning wealth by giving us cows, horses and shining wealth. Make us renowned. The sages born in the Kuśika family, who desire the happiness of heaven and the like and are skilled in rites, have made praise for you, Indra, with words in the form of mantras.

English translation

Gratify this our desire (of wealth) with cows, with horses, with shining treasure, and make us renowned: the wise Kushikas, desirous of heaven, offer praise to you, Indra, with pious (prayers).

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शु॒नं हु॑वेम म॒घवा॑न॒मिन्द्र॑म॒स्मिन्भ॒रे नृत॑मं॒ वाज॑सातौ

।

शृ॒ण्वन्त॑मु॒ग्रमू॒तये॑ स॒मत्सु॒ घ्नन्तं॑ वृ॒त्राणि॑ सं॒जितं॒ धना॑

नाम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *śunaṃ huvema maghavānamindramasminbhare nṛtamaṃ vājasātau |*
> *śṛṇvantamugramūtaye samatsu ghnantaṃ vṛtrāṇi saṃjitaṃ dhanānām ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुनं । हुवेम । मघ्नवानं । इंद्रं । अस्मिन् ! भरे । नृतवं । वाजसात् ।
> शृण्वंतं । उग्रं । ऊतये । समत्सु । घ्नंतं । वृत्राणि । संजितं । धनानां ॥

> *śunaṃ | huvema | maghnavānaṃ | iṃdraṃ | asmin ! bhare | nṛtavaṃ | vājasāt |*
> *śṛṇvaṃtaṃ | ugraṃ | ūtaye | samatsu | ghnaṃtaṃ | vṛtrāṇi | saṃjitaṃ | dhanānāṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वाजसात् । वाजस्यान्नस्य सातिर्लाभो यस्मिन् सोऽयं वाजसातिः।
> अस्मिन्भरे । बिभ्रति जयलक्ष्मीमनेन योद्धार इति भरः संग्रामः । तस्मिन् संग्रामे
> शुनं शूनमुत्साहेन प्रवृद्धं । यद्वा शुनमिति सुखनाम । सुखकरं मघवानं
> धनवंतं अत एवेंद्रं निरतिशयैश्वर्यसंपन्नं नृतमं सर्वस्य जगतोऽतिशयेन
> नेतारं त्वां हुवेम । कुशिका वयं । यज्ञार्थमाह्वयेम । तथा शृण्वंतमस्माभिः
> क्रियमाणां स्तुतिं शृण्वंतमुग्रं शत्रूणां भयंकरं समत्तु संग्रामेषु वृत्राणि
> वृत्रोपलक्षितानि सर्वाणि रक्षांसि घ्नंतं हिंसंतं धनानां शत्रुसंबंधिनां संचितं
> सम्यग्जेतारं त्वामूतये रक्षणाय वयमाह्वयेम ॥ शुनं । टुओत्ति गतिवृद्ध्योरित्यस्य निष्ठायां यस्य
> विभाषेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । दीर्घाभावश्चांदसः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हुवेम ।
> ह्वयतेर्बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणे कृते
> शपो लुकि कृते च लिजि रूपं । निघातः । भरे । भृञ् भरणे । घः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ।
> वाजसात् । षणु दाने । भावे क्तिन् । जनसनेत्यादिनानुनासिकस्यात्वं ।

> बहुप्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । समत्तु अद भक्षणे । संपूर्वात् क्विप् । संभक्षयंति
> योद्धणामायूंषीति समदे संग्रामाः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । घ्नंतं । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य शतरि
> गमहनेत्यादिनोपधालोपः । हो हंतेठिति घत्वं । संजितं ।
> जि जये । क्विप् ॥

> *he iṃdra vājasāt | vājasyānnasya sātirlābho yasmin so 'yaṃ vājasātiḥ|*
> *asminbhare | bibhrati jayalakṣmīmanena yodvāra iti bharaḥ saṃgrāmaḥ*
> *| tasmin saṃgrāme*
> *śunaṃ śūnamutsāhena pravṛddhaṃ | yadvā śunamiti sukhanāma |*
> *sukhakaraṃ maghavānaṃ*
> *dhanavaṃtaṃ ata eveṃdraṃ niratiśayaiśvaryasaṃpannaṃ nṛtamaṃ*
> *sarvasya jagato 'tiśayena*
> *netāraṃ tvāṃ huvema | kuśikā vayaṃ | yajñārthamāhvayema | tathā*
> *śṛṇvaṃtamasmābhiḥ*
> *kriyamāṇāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇvaṃtamugraṃ śatrūṇāṃ bhayaṃkaraṃ samattu*
> *saṃgrāmeṣu vṛtrāṇi*
> *vṛtropalakṣitāni sarvāṇi rakṣāṃsi ghnaṃtaṃ hiṃsaṃtaṃ dhanānāṃ*
> *śatrusaṃbaṃdhināṃ saṃcitaṃ*
> *samyagjetāraṃ tvāmūtaye rakṣaṇāya vayamāhvayema || śunaṃ | ṭuotti*
> *gativṛddhorityasya niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya vibhāṣetīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ |*
> *yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | dīrghābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *huvema | hvayaterbahulaṃ chaṃdasīti saṃprasāraṇe kṛte*
> *śapo luki kṛte ca liji rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ | bhare | bhṛñ bharaṇe | ghaḥ |*
> *vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ | vājasāt | ṣaṇu dāne | bhāve ktin |*
> *janasanetyādinānunāsikasyātvaṃ |*
> *bahuprīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | samattu ada bhakṣaṇe | saṃpūrvāt kvip*
> *| saṃbhakṣayaṃti*
> *yoddhaṇāmāyūṃṣīti samade saṃgrāmāḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ |*
> *ghnaṃtaṃ | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya śatari*
> *gamahanetyādinopadhālopaḥ | ho haṃteṭhiti ghatvaṃ | saṃjitaṃ |*
> *ji jaye | kvip ||*

Summary

"O Indra, in this भरे (*bhare*)", a battle, so called because warriors bear (बिभ्रति (*bibhrati*)) the goddess of victory by it, the "वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)" is that in which there is gain (सातिः (*sātiḥ*)) of food (वाज (*vāja*)). In that battle we call you, शुनं (*śunaṃ*), swollen, that is, grown strong in zeal;

or else शुनमिति (*śunamiti*) is a name for happiness, so, the giver of happiness. You are मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*), wealthy, hence Indra, possessed of unsurpassed lordship, and नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*), the supreme leader of the whole world. We Kuśikas call you for the sacrifice. Likewise you hear the praise made by us, you are fierce (उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)), terrifying to enemies, in battles (समत्सु (*samatsu*)) you slay all the demons marked by Vṛtra, and you are the complete conqueror of the enemies' wealth. We call you, such a one, for protection (ऊतये (*ūtaye*)). The rest is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)—proceeding for the sake of food
- भरे (*bhare*)—in battle
- शुनं (*śunaṃ*)—one who grows with zeal, or one who produces happiness
- मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)—the wealthy one
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—the one endowed with unsurpassed lordship
- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—the one who is the leader; you who are such
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—we pray and call (likewise)
- श्रृण्वंतं (*śṛṇvaṃtaṃ*)—the one who listens to (our praises)
- उग्रं (*ugraṃ*)—the one who is terrible to enemies
- समत्तु (*samattu*)—in battles
- वृत्राणि (*vṛtrāṇi*)—the asuras beginning with Vṛtra
- घ्नंतं (*ghnaṃtaṃ*)—the one who injures and destroys
- धनानां (*dhanānāṃ*)—the wealth (of enemies)
- संचितं (*saṃcitaṃ*)—the one who gathers and gives (to us); you who are such
- ऊतये (*ūtaye*)—for protection
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—I pray and call.

Gist

O Indra, you who give happiness in the battle fought for the sake of food, who are wealthy, endowed with unsurpassed lordship, a leader, who listen to our praises, who are terrible to enemies, who in battles injure and destroy asuras such as Vṛtra, and who gather the wealth of enemies and give it to us — you we pray and call for protection.

English translation

We invoke for our protection the opulent Indra, distinguished in this combat, the leader in the food-bestowing (strife), hearing (our praises), terri- ble in battles, the destroyer of foes, the conqueror of wealth.

Sūkta 51 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> चर्षणीधृतमिति द्वादशर्चं त्रयोदशं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रमैंद्रं । अत्रानुक्रमणिका । चर्षणीधृतं
> द्वादशाद्यांत्यौ तृचौ जागतगायत्राविति । आद्यस्तृचो
> जागतोऽंत्यस्तृचो गायत्रः शिष्टा ऋचस्त्रिष्टुभः ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः ।
> उक्ते क्रत्वा मैत्रा वरुणशस्त्रेऽनुरूपतृचानंतरमाद्यस्तृ चः शंसनीयः । सूत्रितं ।
> च चर्षणीधृतमस्तभ्नाद्द्यामसुर इति तृचौ आ. ६–१ । इति ॥ विषुवति निष्केवल्ये नृणामु
> त्वैति तृचः । विषुवानिति खंडे सूत्रितं । नृणामु त्वा नृतमं गीर्भिरुक्थैरिति
> शिस्त्रः । आ. ८–६ । इति ॥ बृहस्पतिसवेऽप्ययं तृचो निष्केवल्ये निविद्वान्नीयः । सूत्रितं
> च । नृणामु त्वैति मध्यंदिनः । आ. ९–५ । इति ॥ महाव्रतेऽपि निष्केवल्येऽयं तृचः ॥

> *carṣaṇīdhṛtamiti dvādaśarcaṃ trayodaśaṃ sūktaṃ*
> *vaiśvāmitramaiṃdraṃ | atrānukramaṇikā | carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*
> *dvādaśādyāṃtyau tṛcau jāgatagāyatrāviti | ādyastṛco*
> *jāgato 'ṃtyastṛco gāyatraḥ śiṣṭā ṛcastriṣṭubhaḥ ‖ sūktaviniyogo*
> *laiṃgikaḥ |*
> *ukte kratvā maitrā varuṇaśastre 'nurūpatṛcānaṃtaramādyastṛ caḥ*
> *śaṃsanīyaḥ | sūtritaṃ |*
> *ca carṣaṇīdhṛtamastabhnāddāmasura iti tṛcau ā. 6-1 | iti ‖ viṣuvati*
> *niṣkevalye nṛṇāmu tvaiti tṛcaḥ | viṣuvāniti khaṃḍe sūtritaṃ | nṛṇāmu*
> *tvā nṛtamaṃ gīrbhirukthairiti*
> *śistraḥ | ā. 8-6 | iti ‖ bṛhaspatisave 'pyayaṃ tṛco niṣkevalye*
> *nividvānnīyaḥ | sūtritaṃ*
> *ca | nṛṇāmu tvaiti madhyaṃdinaḥ | ā. 9-5 | iti ‖ mahāvrate 'pi*
> *niṣkevalye 'yaṃ tṛcaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*) has twelve Ṛks and is Vaiśvāmitra (its seer is Viśvāmitra) and Aindra (its deity is Indra). The Anukramaṇikā says: चर्षणीधृतं द्वादशाद्यांत्यौ तृचौ जागतगायत्राविति (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ dvādaśādyāṃtyau tṛcau jāgatagāyatrāviti*), i.e. the first triplet is in Jagatī, the last triplet in Gāyatrī, and the remaining Ṛks are in Triṣṭubh. The use of the sūkta is Laiṅgika (by the indication of the text). In the ukthya rite (the Kannada reading उक्ते

क्रत्वा (*ukte kratvā*) is garbled)[?60], in the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra, after the anurūpa triplet, the first triplet of this sūkta is to be recited. It is stated in the sūtra: चर्षणीधृतमस्तभ्नाद्दामसुर इति तृचौ (*carṣaṇīdhṛtamastabhnāddāmasura iti tṛcau*) (Ā. 6-1). At the Viṣuvat in the niṣkevalya the triplet नृणामु त्वा (*nṛṇāmu tvā*) is used; this is stated in the Viṣuvān section: नृणामु त्वा नृतमं गीर्भिरुक्थैरिति शिस्त्रः (*nṛṇāmu tvā nṛtamaṃ gīrbhirukthairiti śistraḥ*)[?61] (Ā. 8-6). In the Bṛhaspatisava also this triplet is used as the nivid in the niṣkevalya; the sūtra says: नृणामु त्वैति मध्यंदिनः (*nṛṇāmu tvaiti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-5). In the Mahāvrata also this triplet is used in the niṣkevalya.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> दशरात्रे चतुर्थेऽहनि मरुत्वतीय इंद्र मरुत्व इति तिस्रः । षष्ठेऽहनि षष्ठस्येति
> खंडे सूत्रितं । इंद्र मरुत्व इति तिस्र इति मरुत्वतीयं । आ. ८–१ । इति ॥ बृहस्पतिसवेऽपि
> मरुत्वतीयशस्त्रेऽयं तृचो निविद्धानीयः । सूत्रितं च । इंद्र मरुत्व
> इह नृणामु तैति मध्यंदिनः । आ ९ ५ । इति । आद्या मरुत्वतीयग्रहस्यानुवाक्या ।
> सूत्रितं च । मरुत्वतीयेन ग्रहेण चरंतींद्र मरुत्व इह पाहि सोमं । आ.
> ५–१४ । इति । तृतीये पर्याये होतुः शस्त्र इदं ह्यन्नोजसेति स्तोत्रियस्तृचः ।
> सूत्रितं च । इदं ह्यन्नोजसा महा इंद्रो य ओजसा । आ. ६–४ । इति ॥

> *daśarātre caturthe 'hani marutvatīya iṃdra marutva iti tisraḥ | ṣaṣṭhe 'hani ṣaṣṭhasyèti*
> *khaṃḍe sūtritaṃ | iṃdra marutva iti tisra iti marutvatīyaṃ | ā. 8-1 | iti || bṛhaspatisave 'pi marutvatīyaśastre 'yaṃ tṛco nividdhānīyaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | iṃdra marutva*
> *iha nṛṇāmu taiti madhyaṃdinaḥ | ā 9 5 | iti | ādyā marutvatīyagrahasyānuvākyā |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | marutvatīyena graheṇa caraṃtīṃdra marutva iha pāhi somaṃ | ā.*
> *5-14 | iti | tṛtīye paryāye hotuḥ śastra idaṃ hyannojaseti stotriyastṛcaḥ |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | idaṃ hyannojasā mahā iṃdro ya ojasā | ā. 6-4 | iti ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the Daśarātra, on the fourth day, at the Marutvatīya, the three Ṛks इंद्र मरुत्व (*iṃdra marutva*) are used; the Khaṇḍa on the sixth day states: इंद्र मरुत्व इति तिस्र इति मरुत्वतीयं (*iṃdra marutva iti tisra iti marutvatīyaṃ*) (Ā. 8-1). In the Bṛhaspatisava also this triplet is used as the nivid in the Marutvatīya śastra; the sūtra says: इंद्र मरुत्व इह नृणामु तैति मध्यंदिनः (*iṃdra marutva iha nṛṇāmu taiti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-5). The first Ṛk is the anuvākyā of the Marutvatīya cup; the sūtra says: मरुत्वतीयेन ग्रहेण चरंतींद्र मरुत्व इह पाहि सोमं (*marutvatīyena graheṇa caraṃtīṃdra marutva iha pāhi somaṃ*) (Ā. 5-14). In the third paryāya, in the Hotṛ's śastra, the triplet इदं ह्यन्नोजसेति (*idaṃ hyannojaseti*) is the stotriya triplet; the sūtra says: इदं ह्यन्नोजसा महा इंद्रो य ओजसा (*idaṃ hyannojasā mahā iṃdro ya ojasā*) (Ā. 6-4).

Anuvāda

The sūkta beginning चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*) is the thirteenth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka. It has twelve Ṛks. Viśvāmitra is the seer of this sūkta and Indra the deity. The Anukramaṇikā says: चर्षणीधृतं द्वादशाद्यांत्यौ तृचौ जागतगायत्राविति (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ dvādaśādyāṃtyau tṛcau jāgatagāyatrāviti*). That is, the first three Ṛks are in the Jagatī metre; the last three are in the Gāyatrī metre; the remaining Ṛks are in the Triṣṭubh metre. The use of the sūkta is Laiṅgika. In the sacrifice called Ukthya, at the time of reciting the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra mantras, after the anurūpa Ṛks (a triplet) have been recited, the first three Ṛks of this sūkta are to be recited; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra: चर्षणीधृतमस्तभ्नाद्यामसुर इति तृचौ (*carṣaṇīdhṛtamastabhnādyāmasura iti tṛcau*) (Ā. 6-1). In the Viṣuvat sacrifice, for the niṣkevalya śastra mantras, three Ṛks beginning नृणामु त्वा (*nṛṇāmu tvā*) (Ṛks 3-5 of this sūkta) are used; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra in the Khaṇḍa called Viṣuvān: नृणामु त्वा नृतमं गीर्भिरुक्कैरिति तिस्रः (*nṛṇāmu tvā nṛtamaṃ gīrbhirukkairiti tisraḥ*) (Ā. 8-6). In the sacrifice called Bṛhaspatisava also, the same three Ṛks beginning नृणामु त्वा (*nṛṇāmu tvā*) are to be used as nivid mantras at the time of reciting the niṣkevalya śastra mantras; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra: नृणामु त्वेति मध्यंदिनः (*nṛṇāmu tveti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-5). In the Mahāvrata also these three Ṛks are recited for the niṣkevalya śastra mantras. In the sacrifice called Daśarātra, on the fourth day, for the Marutvatīya śastra mantras, three Ṛks of this sūkta beginning इंद्र मरुत्व (*iṃdra marutva*) (Ṛks 6-8 of this sūkta) are used; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra in the Khaṇḍa षष्ठेऽहनि षष्ठस्य (*ṣaṣṭhe 'hani ṣaṣṭhasya*) by the sūtra

इंद्रमरुत्व इति तिस्त्र इति मरुत्वतीया (*iṃdramarutva iti tistra iti marutvatīyā*) (Ā. 8-1). In the Bṛhaspatisava also, the three Ṛks just mentioned are to be used as nivid mantras for the Marutvatīya śastra mantras; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra: इंद्र मरुत्व इह नृणामु त्वेति मध्यंदिनः (*iṃdra marutva iha nṛṇāmu tveti madhyaṃdinaḥ*) (Ā. 9-5). The first Ṛk of this sūkta is to be recited as the puronuvākyā mantra of the Marutvatīya cup; the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra says: मरुत्वतीयेन ग्रहेण चरंतींद्र मरुत्व इह पाहि सोमं (*marutvatīyena graheṇa caraṃtīṃdra marutva iha pāhi somaṃ*)

which sūtra explains it (Ā. 5-14). Moreover, in the third paryāya, when the Hotṛ recites the śastra mantra, three Ṛks beginning इदं ह्यन्नोजसा (*idaṃ hyannojasā*) (Ṛks 10-12 of this sūkta) are to be recited as the stotriya triplet; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra: इदं ह्यन्नोजसा महा इंड्रो य ओजसा (*idaṃ hyannojasā mahā iṃḍro ya ojasā*) (Ā. 6-4).

Om.

Sūkta 51.

Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 51.

Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Varga 15, 16.

Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 12.

Ṛṣi: Viśvāmitra.

Devatā: Indra.

Metre: 1-3 Jagatī; 4-9 Triṣṭubh; 10-12 Gāyatrī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

च॒र्ष॒णी॒धृतं᳚ म॒घवा॑नमु॒क्थ्य१॒॑मिन्द्रं॒ गिरो᳚ बृह॒तीर॒भ्यं॑नूषत ।
वा॒वृ॒धा॒नं पुं॑रुहू॒तं सुं॑वृ॒क्तिभि॒रमं॑र्त्यं॒ जरं॑माणं दि॒वेदिं॑वे ॥ १ ॥

> *carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ maghavānamukthyamindraṃ giro bṛhatīrabhyanūṣata |*
> *vāvṛdhānaṃ puruhūtaṃ suvṛktibhiramartyaṃ jaramāṇaṃ divedive ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> चर्षणीधृतं । मघवानं । उक्ष्यं । इंद्रं । गिरः । बृहतीः । अभि । अनूषत ।
> वावृधानं । पुरुहूतं । सुवृक्तिभिः । अमर्त्यं । जरमाणं । दिवेऽदिवे ॥ १ ॥

> *carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ | maghavānaṃ | ukṣyaṃ | iṃdraṃ | giraḥ | bṛhatīḥ | abhi | anūṣata |*
> *vāvṛdhānaṃ | puruhūtaṃ | suvṛktibhiḥ | amartyaṃ | jaramāṇaṃ | dive 'dive ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> बृहतीः प्रभूता गिरोऽस्मदीयाः स्तुतिलक्षणा वाचश्चर्यणेधृतं चर्षणीनां मनुष्याणामभिमतफलप्रदानेन धारकं पोषकं । यद्वा । आकृषंत्यनेन सर्वमिति चर्षन् बलं तद्वारकं । मघवानं धनवंतमुक्त्र्यमुक्त्यैः शस्त्रैः शंसनीयं वावृधानं बलधनादिसंपत्ता प्रतिक्षणं वर्धमानं पुरुहूतु स्तोतृभिर्बहुवारमाहूतममर्त्यं मरणधर्मरहितं सुवृक्तिभिः शोभनस्तुतिवाक्यर्दिवे प्रत्यहं जरमाणं स्तूयमानं तमिमदिंद्रमभ्यनूषत । अभितः सर्वतः स्तुवंतु ॥ बृहतीः ।
> ना छंदसीति सवर्णदीर्घः। अनूषत । णू स्तवने । अस्माल्लुजु सिच् । धातोः कुटादित्वात्सिजो जित्वेन गुणाभावः । सुवृक्तिभिः । नञ्सुभ्यामित्युत्तरपदांतोदात्तत्वं।
> यद्वा ! सुवृक्तय इति स्तुतिकरणभूता ऋचो व्यक्तिशब्देनोच्यंते । क्तिच्क्त्य चेति क्तिच् । कृत्सरेणांतोदात्तः । दिवे दिवे । नित्यवीप्सयोरिति द्विर्वचनं । परस्याम्रेडितत्पादनुदात्तत्वे पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *bṛhatīḥ prabhūtā giro 'smadīyāḥ stutilakṣaṇā vācaścaryaṇedhṛtaṃ carṣaṇīnāṃ*
> *manuṣyāṇāmabhimataphalapradānena dhārakaṃ poṣakaṃ | yadvā | ākṛṣaṃtyanena sarvamiti*
> *carṣan balaṃ tadvārakaṃ | maghavānaṃ dhanavaṃtamuktryamuktyaiḥ śastraiḥ śaṃsanīyaṃ vāvṛdhānaṃ baladhanādisaṃpattā pratikṣaṇaṃ vardhamānaṃ puruhūtu stotṛbhirbahuvāramāhūtamamartyaṃ maraṇadharmarahitaṃ suvṛktibhiḥ śobhanastutivākyardive pratyahaṃ jaramāṇaṃ stūyamānaṃ tamimadiṃdramabhyanūṣata | abhitaḥ sarvataḥ stuvaṃtu ‖ bṛhatīḥ |*
> *nā chaṃdasīti savarṇadīrghaḥ| anūṣata | ṇū stavane | asmālluju sic | dhātoḥ kuṭāditvātsijo jitvena guṇābhāvaḥ | suvṛktibhiḥ | nañsubhyāmityuttarapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ|*
> *yadvā ! suvṛktaya iti stutikaraṇabhūtā ṛco vyaktiśabdenocyaṃte | kticktya ceti*
> *ktic | kṛtsareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | dive dive | nityavīpsayoriti dvirvacanaṃ | parasyāmreḍitatpādanudāttatve pūrvapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

बृहतीः (*bṛhatīḥ*): abundant; गिरः (*giraḥ*): our words in the form of praise. They should praise this Indra on every side (अभ्यनूषत (*abhyanūṣata*)). Indra is चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*): the upholder, nourisher, of men (चर्षणीनां (*carṣaṇīnāṃ*)) by granting the fruit they desire. Or else: that by which everything is drawn is चर्षन् (*carṣan*), strength, and he is its holder. मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*): the wealthy; the ukthya: to be praised by ukthas, by śastras; वावृधानं (*vāvṛdhānaṃ*): increasing every moment through the wealth of strength, riches and the like; पुरुहूतं (*puruhūtaṃ*): called many times by the singers; अमर्त्यं (*amartyaṃ*): free from the nature of death; सुवृक्तिभिः (*suvṛktibhiḥ*): with good words of praise; दिवे दिवे (*dive dive*): every day; जरमाणं (*jaramāṇaṃ*): being praised. अभितः (*abhitaḥ*) means on all sides; "let them praise". Or else: सुवृक्तय (*suvṛktaya*) are the Ṛks, the instruments of praise, which are called by the word vṛkti.

Word-to-word meaning

- चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*)—the nourisher of men

- मघवानं (*maghavānaṃ*)—the wealthy
- उक्ष्यं (*ukṣyaṃ*)—the one praised by hymns in the form of ukṣa[?] 62
- वावृधानं (*vāvṛdhānaṃ*)—the one who grows through wealth
- पुरुहूतं (*puruhūtaṃ*)—the one called by many
- अमर्त्यं (*amartyaṃ*)—the one free from the nature of death
- सुवृक्तिभिः (*suvṛktibhiḥ*)—with excellent words of praise
- दिवे दिवे (*dive dive*)—every day
- जरमाणं (*jaramāṇaṃ*)—the one who is praised
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- बृहतीः (*bṛhatīḥ*)—abundant
- गिरः (*giraḥ*)—our words of praise
- अभ्यनूषत (*abhyanūṣata*)—let them praise fully.

Gist

May our abundant words of praise praise fully Indra, who nourishes men, is wealthy, is praised by hymns in the uktha form, grows through wealth, is called by many, is free from the nature of death, and is praised every day with excellent words of praise.

English translation

Let abundant praises celebrate Indra, the stay of man, the possessor of opulence, the adorable, prospering with increase, the invoked of many, the immortal, who is daily to be propitiated with sacred hymns.

Special Topics

चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*)—मनुष्याणामभिमतफलप्रदानेन धारकं पोषकं (*manuṣyāṇāmabhimataphalapradānena dhārakaṃ poṣakaṃ*). यद्वा अकृषंत्यनेन सर्वमिति चर्षणि बलं तद्धारकं (*yadvā akṛṣaṃtyanena sarvamiti carṣaṇi balaṃ taddhārakaṃ*). The word चर्षणी (*carṣaṇī*) is read among the names of man (Ni. 3-7). Because Indra gives and protects the fruits that correspond to the sacrifices and other rites performed by men, he is called चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*). Or else, since everything is drawn, the word चर्षणी (*carṣaṇī*) is understood to mean strength; Indra is praised as the one who holds such strength, that is, as mighty.

उक्थं (*ukthaṃ*)—उक्थैः शस्त्रैः शंसनीयं (*ukthaiḥ śastraiḥ śaṃsanīyaṃ*). Uktha means hymn. The sense is: Indra, who is praised both by hymns and by śastra mantras.

पुरुहूतं (*puruhūtaṃ*)—स्तोतृभिर्बहुवारमाहूतं (*stotṛbhirbahuvāramāhūtaṃ*). The one called many times by the people who sing hymns; or by many people, that is, the one invited by the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice, the priests, other singers and the like.

सुवृक्तिभिः (*suvṛktibhiḥ*)—स्तुतिकरणभूता ऋचो व्यक्तिशब्देनोच्यंते (*stutikaraṇabhūtā ṛco vyaktiśabdenocyaṃte*). Ṛks that are devoted to praise are named vyakti (vṛkti). For this word Yāska has given the explanation सुप्रवृत्ताभिः शोभनाभिः स्तुतिभिः (*supravṛttābhiḥ śobhanābhiḥ stutibhiḥ*) (Ni. 2-24): with excellent words of praise.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

श॒तक्र॑तुमर्ण॒वं शा॒किनं॒ नरं॒ गिरो॑ म॒ इन्द्र॒मुप॑ यन्ति वि॒श्वत॑ः ।
वा॒ज॒सनिं॑ पू॒र्भिदं॒ तूर्णिं॑म॒प्तुरं॑ धाम॒साचं॑मभि॒षाचं॑ स्व॒र्विदं॑म् ॥ २ ॥

> *śatakratumarṇavaṃ śākinaṃ naraṃ giro ma indramupa yanti viśvataḥ |*
> *vājasaniṃ pūrbhidaṃ tūrṇimapturaṃ dhāmasācamabhiṣācaṃ svarvidam ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शत्क्रतुं । अर्णवं । शाकिनं । नरं । गिरः । मे । इंद्रं । उप । यंति । विश्वतः ।
> वाजसनिं । पूःभिदं । तोर्णिं । अप्तुरं । धामसाचं । अभिसाचं । स्वःविदम् ॥ २ ॥

> *śatkratuṃ | arṇavaṃ | śākinaṃ | naraṃ | giraḥ | me | iṃdraṃ | upa | yaṃti | viśvataḥ |*
> *vājasaniṃ | pūḥbhidaṃ | torṇiṃ | apturaṃ | dhāmasācaṃ | abhisācaṃ | svaḥvidam ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मे मदीया गिरः स्तुतिलक्षणा वाचः शतक्रतुं । शतं क्रतवो यज्ञा यस्य
> तं । अर्णवं पर्जन्यात्मनोदकवंतं शाकिनं । शक्नोत्येभिरिंद्र इति शाकाः सहायभूता मरुतः ।
> तद्वंतं। नरं सर्वस्य जगतो नेतारं वाजसनिं वाजस्यान्नस्य दातारं
> पूर्भिदं शत्रुपुरां भेत्तारं तूर्णिं युद्धं प्रति शीघ्रं गंतारमप्पुरं मेघभेदनद्वारापां प्रेरकं धामसाचं तेजो भजमानं । यद्वा धनं धाम । तदर्थिभिः
> सह योजयितारं । अभिषाचं शत्रूणामभिभवितारं स्वर्विदं स्वर्गस्य लंभकं तमिमनिंद्रं विश्वतः सर्वत उप यंति । उपगच्छंतु ॥ अर्णवं । अर्णोऽस्यास्तीति
> मत्त्वर्थेऽर्णसः सलोॅपश्चति वप्रत्ययः सकारलोपश्च । प्रत्ययस्वरः । नरं । नयतेर्डिच्चेत्कृप्रत्ययः । अमः सुप्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे प्रत्ययस्वरः । यंति । इण् गतावित्यस्य लटीणो यणिति यण् ।
> निघातः । वाजसनिं । षणु दाने । खनिकष्यंज्यसिवसीत्यादिना इप्रत्ययः ; परादिष्पंदसि बहुलमित्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । तूर्णिं ।
> इत्वरा संभ्रमे । वहिश्रीत्यादिना निप्रत्ययः । ज्वरत्वरेत्यादिना ऊट् ।
> निदित्यतिदेशादाद्युदात्तः । अप्पुरं । तुर त्वर्णे । क्विप् । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । अभिषाचं । षच समवाये । ण्यंतस्य क्विप् ॥

> *me madīyā giraḥ stutilakṣaṇā vācaḥ śatakratuṃ | śataṃ kratavo yajñā yasya*
> *taṃ | arṇavaṃ parjanyātmanodakavaṃtaṃ śākinaṃ | śaknotyebhiriṃdra iti śākāḥ sahāyabhūtā marutaḥ | tadvaṃtaṃ| naraṃ sarvasya jagato netāraṃ vājasaniṃ vājasyānnasya dātāraṃ*
> *pūrbhidaṃ śatrupurāṃ bhettāraṃ tūrṇiṃ yuddhaṃ prati śīghraṃ gaṃtāramappuraṃ meghabhedanadvārāpāṃ prerakaṃ dhāmasācaṃ tejo bhajamānaṃ | yadvā dhanaṃ dhāma | tadarthibhiḥ*
> *saha yojayitāraṃ | abhiṣācaṃ śatrūṇāmabhibhavitāraṃ svarvidaṃ svargasya laṃbhakaṃ tamimaniṃdraṃ viśvataḥ sarvata upa yaṃti | upagacchaṃtu ‖ arṇavaṃ | arṇo 'syāstīti*
> *mattvarthe 'rṇasaḥ salòpaścati vapratyayaḥ sakāralopaśca | pratyayasvaraḥ | naraṃ | nayaterḍiccetkṛpratyayaḥ | amaḥ suptvādanudāttatve pratyayasvaraḥ | yaṃti | iṇ gatāvityasya laṭīṇo yaṇiti yaṇ | nighātaḥ | vājasaniṃ | ṣaṇu dāne | khanikaṣyaṃjyasivasītyādinā ipratyayaḥ ; parādiṣpaṃdasi*

> *bahulamityuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | tūrṇiṃ |*
> *itvarā saṃbhrame | vahiśrīyādinā nipratyayaḥ | jvaratvaretyādinā ūṭ |*
> *nidityatideśādādyudāttaḥ | appuraṃ | tura tvarṇe | kvip |*
> *kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | abhiṣācaṃ | ṣaca samavāye | ṇyaṃtasya kvip ||*

Summary

मे मदीया गिरः (*me madīyā giraḥ*): my words in the form of praise should approach on every side (विश्वतः (*viśvataḥ*), from all directions) this Indra (उप यंति (*upa yaṃti*): let them approach), who is: शतक्रतुं (*śatakratuṃ*), he of whom there are a hundred sacrifices (kratu); अर्णवं (*arṇavaṃ*), the possessor of water in the form of Parjanya; शाकिनं (*śākinaṃ*), he by whom Indra is able — the शाकाः (*śākāḥ*) are the Maruts, who are his helpers — the possessor of them; नरं (*naraṃ*), the leader of the whole world; वाजसनिं (*vājasaniṃ*), the giver of food (वाज (*vāja*)); पूर्भिदं (*pūrbhidaṃ*), the breaker of the cities of enemies; तूर्णिं (*tūrṇiṃ*), one who goes swiftly to battle; अप्पुरं (*appuraṃ*), the impeller of the waters by splitting the cloud; धामसाचं (*dhāmasācaṃ*), one who partakes of splendour; or else धाम (*dhāma*) is wealth, and he is the one who unites with those who desire it; अभिषाचं (*abhiṣācaṃ*), the overcomer of enemies; स्वर्विदं (*svarvidaṃ*), the obtainer of heaven.

Word-to-word meaning

- मे (*me*)—my
- गिरः (*giraḥ*)—words in the form of praise
- शतक्रतुं (*śatakratuṃ*)—the performer of many sacrifices
- अर्णवं (*arṇavaṃ*)—the one filled with water as Parjanya
- शाकिनं (*śākinaṃ*)—the one accompanied by the Maruts
- नरं (*naraṃ*)—the one who is the leader
- वाजसनिं (*vājasaniṃ*)—the giver of food
- पूर्विदं (*pūrvidaṃ*)—the destroyer of enemy cities
- तूर्णिं (*tūrṇiṃ*)—the one who runs toward battle
- अफ्पुरं (*aphpuraṃ*)—the one who pours down rain
- धामसाचं (*dhāmasācaṃ*)—the one endowed with splendour
- अभिषाचं (*abhiṣācaṃ*)—the conqueror of enemies
- स्वर्विदं (*svarvidaṃ*)—the one who brings heaven within reach; who is such

- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- विश्वतः (*viśvataḥ*)—from all sides
- उप यंति (*upa yaṃti*)—let them approach and join.

Gist

May my words in the form of praise approach and join, from all sides, Indra, who is the performer of many sacrifices, filled with water as Parjanya, accompanied by the Maruts, the leader, the giver of food, the destroyer of enemy cities, who runs toward battle, pours down rain, is endowed with splendour, conquers enemies and brings heaven within reach.

English translation

My praiscs constantly propitiate Indra, the object of many rites, the sender of rian attended by the Maruts, the leader (of all), the giver of food,

the destroyer of cities, the swift (in combat), the prompt (dispenser) of waters, the distributors of riches, the subduer of foes, the conferrer of heaven.

Special Topics

शतक्रतुं (*śatakratuṃ*)—शतं क्रतवो यज्ञा यस्य तं (*śataṃ kratavo yajñā yasya taṃ*). The commentator explains Indra as Śatakratu because he performed a hundred sacrifices. But this explanation follows a Purāṇic statement. Nowhere in the Vedas is it said that Indra performed a hundred sacrifices and so obtained the rank of Indra. If the word is explained in accordance with the Vedic sense, śata means "hundreds" or "many", and kratu means "deed" or "feat of daring"; Śatakratu then means one who has performed hundreds (many) of heroic deeds such as the slaying of Vṛtra. To explain it so is the proper course.

शाकिनं (*śākinaṃ*)—शक्नोत्येभिरिंद्र इति शाकाः सहायभूता मरुतः तद्वंतं (*śaknotyebhiriṃdra iti śākāḥ sahāyabhūtā marutaḥ tadvaṃtaṃ*). Because they help, the Maruts are called Śākāḥ. Indra, who has obtained the help of those Marut deities, is called Śākī.

पूर्भिदं (*pūrbhidaṃ*)—शुत्रपुरां भेत्तारं (*śutrapurāṃ bhettāraṃ*). The destroyer of enemy cities. Epithets such as पुरां भिंदुः (*purāṃ bhiṃduḥ*) describe Indra as the destroyer of enemy cities in many Ṛks.

धामसाचं (*dhāmasācaṃ*)—तेजो भजमानं । यद्वा धनं धाम । तदर्थिभिः सह योजयितारं (*tejo bhajamānaṃ* | *yadvā dhanaṃ dhāma* | *tadarthibhiḥ saha yojayitāraṃ*). The commentator gives two explanations: one who shines with splendour; or, if dhāma is taken to mean wealth, one who provides wealth to the people who praise him.

स्वर्विदं (*svarvidaṃ*)—स्वर्गस्य लंभकं (*svargasya laṃbhakaṃ*). One who obtains heaven, that is, one who goes to heaven, or dwells in heaven, or secures heaven for people.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒क॒रे वसो॑र्जरि॒ता प॑नस्यतेऽने॒हस॒ः स्तुभ॒ इन्द्रो॑
दुवस्यति ।
वि॒वस्व॑त॒ः सद॑न॒ आ हि पि॑प्रि॒ये स॑त्रा॒साह॑मभिमाति॒
हनं॑ स्तुहि ॥ ३ ॥

> *ākare vasorjaritā panasyate 'nehasaḥ stubha indro duvasyati |*
> *vivasvataḥ sadana ā hi pipriye satrāsāhamabhimātihanaṃ stuhi ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आकरे । वसोः । जरिता । पनस्यते । अनेहसः । स्तुभः । इंद्रः । दुवस्यति ।
> विवस्वतः । सदने । आ । हि । पिप्रिये । सत्रासहं । अभिमातिहनं । स्तुहि ॥ ३ ॥

> *ākare* | *vasoḥ* | *jaritā* | *panasyate* | *anehasaḥ* | *stubhaḥ* | *iṃdraḥ* |
> *duvasyati* |
> *vivasvataḥ* | *sadane* | *ā* | *hi* | *pipriye* | *satrāsahaṃ* | *abhimātihanaṃ* |
> *stuhi* ‖ *3* ‖

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> जरिता शत्रूणां जरयितेंद्र आकरे । आकीर्यते यद्वार्थं धनमत्रेत्याकरो युद्धं ।
> तस्मिन्वसोर्धनस्य स्थानभूते युद्धे पनस्यते । सर्वैः स्तूयते ।
> यद्वा वसोः । वसत्याभिमुख्येन तिष्ठतीति वसुः शत्रुस्तस्य जरयितेति योजनीयं ।
> स इंद्रोऽनेहसोऽपापाः स्तुभः स्तुतीर्दुवस्यति । परिचरति । तासां फलं प्रयच्छन्
> पूजयतीत्यर्थः । किंच स इंद्रो विवस्वतो विशेषेणाग्निहोत्रार्थं वसतो
> हविष्मतो ना यजमानस्य सदने गृह आ पिप्रिये हि । सोमपानादिनात्यंतं प्रीतो
> भवति खलु । सत्रासाहं शत्रूणामेव हंतारं यद्वा मरुद्भिः सह शत्रूणामभिभवितारं अत
> एवाभिमातिहनं शत्रूणां हंतारमिंद्रं स्तुहि । हे विश्वामित्रेति ॥ आकरे
> कृ विक्षेपे । अधिकरण यूदोरबित्यप् । थाथादिस्वरेणांतोदात्तः । जरिता । जृष्
> वयोहानानित्य स्यांतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य तृचि रूपं । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । पनस्यते ।
> पनस्यतिः स्तुतिकर्मा । तस्य कर्मणि लटि रूपं । निघातः । अनेहसः । हंतेर्नञ्युपपदे नञ
> हन एह चेत्यसिप्रत्यय एह इत्ययं चादेशो धातोः । नञ सुभ्यामिति
> स्वरेणांतोदात्तः । स्तुभः । स्तोभतिरर्चतिकर्मा । क्विप् । दुवस्यति । दुवः परिचरणमात्मन
> इच्छतीत्यर्थे क्यच् । निघातः । पिप्रिये । प्रीज् तर्पणी । लिट रूपं ।
> हियोगादनिघातः ॥

> *jaritā śatrūṇāṃ jarayiteṃdra ākare | ākīryate yadvārthaṃ*
> *dhanamatretyākaro yuddhaṃ | tasminvasordhanasya sthānabhūte*
> *yuddhe panasyate | sarvaiḥ stūyate |*
> *yadvā vasoḥ | vasatyābhimukhyena tiṣṭhatīti vasuḥ śatrustasya jarayiteti*
> *yojanīyaṃ |*
> *sa iṃdro 'nehaso 'pāpāḥ stubhaḥ stutīrduvasyati | paricarati | tāsāṃ*
> *phalaṃ prayacchan pūjayatītyarthaḥ | kiṃca sa iṃdro vivasvato*
> *viśeṣeṇāgnihotrārthaṃ vasato*
> *haviṣmato nā yajamānasya sadane gṛha ā pipriye hi |*
> *somapānādinātyaṃtaṃ prīto*
> *bhavati khalu | satrāsāhaṃ śatrūṇāmeva haṃtāraṃ yadvā marudbhiḥ*
> *saha śatrūṇāmabhibhavitāraṃ ata evābhimātihanaṃ śatrūṇāṃ*
> *haṃtāramiṃdraṃ stuhi | he viśvāmitreti ‖ ākare*
> *kṛ vikṣepe | adhikaraṇa yūdorabityap | thāthādisvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ |*
> *jaritā | jṛṣ*
> *vayohānānitya syāṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya tṛci rūpaṃ |*
> *citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | panasyate |*
> *panasyatiḥ stutikarmā | tasya karmaṇi laṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ |*
> *anehasaḥ | haṃternaiyupapade naña hana eha cetyasipratyaya eha*

> *ityayaṃ cādeśo dhātoḥ | naña subhyāmiti*
> *svareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | stubhaḥ | stobhatirarcatikarmā | kvip | duvasyati |*
> *duvaḥ paricaraṇamātmana icchatītyarthè kyac | nighātaḥ | pipriye | prīj*
> *tarpaṇī | liṭa rūpaṃ |*
> *hiyogādanighātaḥ ||*

Summary

Jaritā is Indra, who makes his enemies decay. आकरे (*ākare*): that in which wealth is scattered about (or for the sake of which it is gathered) is ākara, battle. In that battle, the place of wealth (vasu), he is praised (panasyate) by all. Or else vasoḥ: vasu is the enemy who stands facing him, and the sense is "the one who makes him decay". That Indra serves (duvasyati) the sinless praises (stubhaḥ): he honours them by granting their fruit. Further, Indra is greatly pleased at the house of the sacrificer (विवस्वतः (*vivasvataḥ*)), who dwells especially for the Agnihotra and has oblations, through Soma-drinking and the like. "Conqueror, slayer of enemies; or one who with the Maruts overcomes enemies; therefore the slayer of the foe: praise that Indra, O Viśvāmitra." The remainder is grammar on ākare, jaritā, panasyate, anehasaḥ, stubhaḥ, duvasyati and pipriye.

Word-to-word meaning

- जरिता (*jaritā*)—destroyer of enemies
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- आकरे (*ākare*)—in battle
- वसोः (*vasoḥ*)—for the gaining of wealth
- पनस्यते (*panasyate*)—is praised (by all)
- अनेहसः (*anehasaḥ*)—sinless
- स्तुमः (*stumaḥ*)—praises[?63]
- दुवस्यति (*duvasyati*)—serves
- विवस्वतः (*vivasvataḥ*)—of the sacrificer
- सदने (*sadane*)—in the sacrificial house
- आ पिप्रिये (*ā pipriye*)—is satisfied with Soma and other drinks
- (O Viśvāmitra) सत्रासाहं (*satrāsāhaṃ*)—the conqueror of enemies
- अभिमातिहनं (*abhimātihanaṃ*)—the slayer of arrogant enemies, Indra

- स्तुहि (*stuhi*)—praise

Gist

Indra, the destroyer of enemies, is praised by all in battle for the gaining of wealth. He serves the sinless praises. In the sacrificial houses of the sacrificer he is satisfied with Soma and other drinks. O Viśvāmitra, praise Indra, the conqueror of enemies and slayer of arrogant foes.

English translation

Indra, the enfeebler (of adversaries), is praised as a mine of wealth; he is propitiated by righteous commendations; he is gratified in the dwelling of the offerer of oblations: glorify Indra, the conquerer, the destroyer of his enemies.

Special Topics

आकरे एसोः (*ākare esoḥ*)—कृ विक्षेपे । आकीर्यते धनमत्रेत्याकरो युद्धं तस्मिन् (*kṛ vikṣepe | ākīryate dhanamatretyākaro yuddhaṃ tasmin*). The word ākara is derived from the root kṛ, meaning to scatter, to collect. Because in battle the victors collect the wealth of the defeated enemies, battle is called ākara, the commentator explains.

अनेहसः स्तुभ इंद्रो दुवस्यति (*anehasaḥ stubha iṃdro duvasyati*)—अपापाः स्तुतीः परिचरति । शासां फलं प्रयच्छन् पूजयतीत्यर्थः (*apāpāḥ stutīḥ paricarati | śāsāṃ phalaṃ prayacchan pūjayatītyarthaḥ*). People praise Indra with sinless praises; the sense is that Indra gives such people the fruit and honours them.

विवस्वतः सदने आ हि पिप्रिये (*vivasvataḥ sadane ā hi pipriye*) विशेषेणाग्निहोत्रार्थं वसतो हविष्मतो वा यजमानस्य गृहे सोमपानादिनात्यंतं प्रीतो भवति खलु (*viśeṣeṇāgnihotrārthaṃ vasato haviṣmato vā yajamānasya gṛhe somapānādinātyaṃtaṃ prīto bhavati khalu*). It is described here that in the house of sacrificers who dwell performing good rites such as the Agnihotra and stand ready to offer oblations, Indra is happy, drinking Soma.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नृ॒णामु॑ त्वा॒ नृत॑मं गी॒र्भिरु॒क्थैर॒भि प्र वी॒रम॑र्चता स॒बाध॑ः ।
सं सह॑से पुरुमा॒यो जिं॑हीते॒ नमो॑ अस्य प्र॒दिव॒ एक॑ ईशे ॥ ४ ॥

> *nṛṇāmu tvā nṛtamaṃ gīrbhirukthairabhi pra vīramarcatā sabādhaḥ |*
> *saṃ sahase purumāyo jihīte namo asya pradiva eka īśe ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नृणां । ऊं इति । त्वा । नृतमं । गीःभिः । उक्थैः । अभि । प्र । वीरं । अर्चत ।
> सबाधः ।
> सं । सहसे । पुरुमायः । जिहीते । नमः । अस्य । प्रदिवः । एकः । ईशे ॥ ४ ॥

> *nṛṇāṃ | ūṃ iti | tvā | nṛtamaṃ | gīḥbhiḥ | ukthaiḥ | abhi | pra | vīraṃ | arcata |*
> *sabādhaḥ |*
> *saṃ | sahase | purumāyaḥ | jihīte | namaḥ | asya | pradivaḥ | ekaḥ | īśe ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र सबाधः । रघोघ्नमंत्रोच्चारणेन तद्विषयबाधया सह वर्तंत इति सबाध ऋत्विजः । नृणां नृतमं मनुष्याणामतिशयेन स्वकर्मणि नेतारं वीरं सामर्थ्योपेतं त्वां गीर्भिः स्तुतिसाधनभूतैर्वाक्यैरुक्थैः शस्त्रैश्चाभ्याभिमुख्येन प्रार्चत । प्रकर्षणार्चंति । पुरुमायो वृत्रहननादिबहुकर्मा स इंद्रः सहसे बलाय सं जिहीते । गमनोद्यमं करोति । किंच प्रदिवः पुरातन एकोऽसहायः स इंद्रो नमो नमसोऽस्य हविर्लक्षणस्यान्नस्येशे । ईष्टे । यद्वा अस्य सर्वस्य जगत ईष्टे । तस्मा इंद्राय नमः ॥ नृणां । नामन्यतरस्यामिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । अर्चत । अर्चतेर्लटि झेस्तादेशः तिजां जो भवंतीति वचनात् । सबाधः । बाध्य विलोडने । क्विप् । वोपसर्जनस्येति सहस्य सत्वं । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । पुरुमाये॑ः । अंतोदात्तप्रकरणे त्रिचक्रादीनामुपसंख्यानमित्यंतोदात्तत्वं । ईशे । ईश ऐश्वर्य इत्यस्य लट लोपस्त आत्मनेपदेष्विति तलोपः । निघातः ॥

> *he iṃdra sabādhaḥ | raghoghnamaṃtroccāraṇena tadviṣayabādhayā saha vartaṃta*
> *iti sabādha ṛtvijaḥ | nṛṇāṃ nṛtamaṃ manuṣyāṇāmatiśayena svakarmaṇi netāraṃ vīraṃ*
> *sāmarthyopetaṃ tvāṃ gīrbhiḥ stutisādhanabhūtairvākyairukthaiḥ śastraiścābhyābhimukhyena*
> *prārcata | prakarṣaṇārcaṃti | purumāyo vṛtrahananādibahukarmā sa iṃdraḥ sahase*
> *balāya saṃ jihīte | gamanodyamaṃ karoti | kiṃca pradivaḥ purātana eko 'sahāyaḥ*
> *sa iṃdro namo namaso 'sya havirlakṣaṇasyānnasyeśe | īṣṭe | yadvā asya sarvasya*
> *jagata īṣṭe | tasmā iṃdrāya namaḥ ‖ nṛṇāṃ | nāmanyatarasyāmiti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ |*
> *arcata | arcaterlaṭi jhestādeśaḥ tijāṃ jo bhavaṃtīti vacanāt | sabādhaḥ | bādhya*
> *viloḍane | kvip | vopasarjanasyèti sahasya satvaṃ |*
> *kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | purumāyèḥ |*
> *aṃtodāttaprakaraṇe tricakrādīnāmupasaṃkhyānamityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | īśe | īśa*
> *aiśvarya ityasya laṭa lopasta ātmanepadeṣṭiti talopaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, the priests (sabādhaḥ: those who, by reciting the Rakṣoghna mantras, live with the harassment of the demons concerned) honour you, the foremost leader of men in his own work, the hero endowed with strength, with praises, the words that serve as means of praise, and with ukthas (śastras), facing you. Indra, of many exploits such as slaying Vṛtra, sets out for strength. Further, he, ancient and alone without helper, is lord of this nama, the food in the form of oblation; or else he is lord of this whole world, so homage to that Indra. The rest is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) सबाधः (*sabādhaḥ*)—priests
- नृणां (*nṛṇāṃ*)—of all men

- नृतमं (*nṛtamaṃ*)—the pre-eminent leader
- वीरं (*vīraṃ*)—and endowed with strength
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)—with words in the form of praise
- उक्षैः (*ukṣaiḥ*)—with mantras in the form of śastras
- अभि (*abhi*)—sitting before you
- प्र अर्चत (*pra arcata*)—worship exceedingly
- पुरुमायः (*purumāyaḥ*)—Indra, the doer of many valorous deeds
- सहसे (*sahase*)—for the gaining of strength
- सं जिहीते (*saṃ jihīte*)—wishes to move about
- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—the ancient
- एकः (*ekaḥ*)—the unaided Indra
- नमः अस्य (*namaḥ asya*)—for this food in the form of oblation
- ईशे (*īśe*)—desires

Gist

O Indra, the priests, sitting before you, worship exceedingly you, the pre-eminent leader of all men, endowed with strength, with words in the form of praise and mantras in the form of śastras. Indra, the doer of many valorous deeds, wishes to move about to gain strength. Indra, the ancient and unaided, desires this food in the form of oblation.

English translation

The priests glorify you, heroic leader of men, with praises and with prayers : Indra, the author of many delusions, exerts himself for (the acquirement of) strength : he from of old is the lord of this (oblation).

Special Topics

सबाधः (*sabādhaḥ*)—रक्षोघ्नमंत्रोच्चारणेन तद्विषयबाधया सह वर्तंत इति सबाध ऋत्विजः (*rakṣoghnamaṃtroccāraṇena tadviṣayabādhayā saha vartaṃta iti sabādha ṛtvijaḥ*). In sacrifices and the like, Rākṣasas and others cause obstacles. To remove them the priests recite Rakṣoghna mantras. Therefore priests accompanied by harassment from Rākṣasas are called sabādhaḥ; thus the component meaning of the word is explained. Yāska reads the word sabādhaḥ among the names of priests (Ni. 3-19).

पुरुमायः (*purumāyaḥ*)—वृत्रहननादिबहुकर्मा (*vṛtrahananādibahukarmā*). Because in the work of destroying enemies Indra displays many kinds of māyā (devices, stratagems) and daring, he is described as Purumāyaḥ, one who has done many daring deeds.

नमः अस्य प्रदिवः एकः ईशे (*namaḥ asya pradivaḥ ekaḥ īśe*)—पुरातनः असहायः स इंद्रो हविर्लक्षणस्यान्नस्य ईष्टे । यद्वा अस्य सर्वस्य जगत ईष्टे । तस्मा इंद्राय नमः (*purātanaḥ asahāyaḥ sa iṃdro havirlakṣaṇasyānnasya īṣṭe | yadvā asya sarvasya jagata īṣṭe | tasmā iṃdrāya namaḥ*). The commentator's explanation is that this sentence admits two meanings. If nama is taken to mean food (Ni. 3-9), then Indra, ancient and heroic without helper, is lord of the food in the form of oblation, that is, the oblation must be offered to Indra. If nama is taken to mean homage, then Indra is lord of this whole world, and homage is due to such an Indra.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पू॒र्वीर॑स्य नि॒ष्षिधो॒ मर्त्ये॑षु पु॒रू वसू॑नि पृथि॒वी बि॑भर्ति ।
इन्द्रा॑य॒ द्याव॒ ओष॑धीरु॒तापो॑ र॒यिं र॑क्षन्ति जी॒रयो॒ वना॑नि ॥ ५ ॥

> *pūrvīrasya niṣṣidho martyeṣu purū vasūni pṛthivī bibharti |*
> *indrāya dyāva oṣadhīrutāpo rayiṃ rakṣanti jīrayo vanāni ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पूर्वीः । अस्य । निःसिधः । मर्त्येषु । पुरु । वसूनि । पृथिवी । बिभर्ति ।
> इंद्राय । द्यावः । ओषधीः । उत । आसः । रयिं । रक्षंति । जीरयः । वनानि ॥ ५ ॥

> *pūrvīḥ | asya | niḥsidhaḥ | martyeṣu | puru | vasūni | pṛthivī | bibharti |*
> *iṃdrāya | dyāvaḥ | oṣadhīḥ | uta | āsaḥ | rayiṃ | rakṣaṃti | jīrayaḥ | vanāni ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मर्त्येषु मनुष्यस्येंद्रस्य निष्पिधोऽनुशासनानि पूर्विर्हितोपदेशादिभिः
> प्रभूतानि नानाप्रकाराणि भवंति । इंद्रस्य शासितृवे मंत्रः । उक्धमिंद्राय शंस्यं
> वर्धनं पुरुनिष्ठिधे । ऋग्वे. १–१०–५ । इति । तथा शासकाय तस्मा इंद्राय पृथिवी
> पुरु पुरूणि बहूनि वसूनि धनानि बिभर्ति । अंतर्धारयति । किंच द्यावो द्युलोका
> ओषधीरोषधय उत अपि चापो जलानि जीरयः । जीय्यंत इति जीरयो
> मनुष्याः । वनानि वृक्षाश्च एते सर्व इंद्रस्याज्ञया तदुपभोगयोग्यं रयिं धनं
> रक्षंति ॥ निष्पिधः । षिधु गत्यां । क्विप् । संहितायां निसः सकारेणेणो व्यवधानं
> छांदसत्वादनादृत्योपसर्गात्सुनोतीत्यादिना षत्वं । निसः सकारस्य ष्टुना ष्टुरिति
> षत्वं ॥

> *martyeṣu manuṣyasyeṃdrasya niṣpidho 'nuśāsanāni pūrvirhitopadeśādibhiḥ*
> *prabhūtāni nānāprakārāṇi bhavaṃti | iṃdrasya śāsitṛve maṃtraḥ | ukdhamiṃdrāya śaṃsyaṃ*
> *vardhanaṃ puruniṣṭhidhe | ṛgve. 1-10-5 | iti | tathā śāsakāya tasmā iṃdrāya pṛthivī*
> *puru purūṇi bahūni vasūni dhanāni bibharti | aṃtardhārayati | kiṃca dyāvo dyulokā*
> *oṣadhīroṣadhaya uta api cāpo jalāni jīrayaḥ | jīyyaṃta iti jīrayo*
> *manuṣyāḥ | vanāni vṛkṣāśca ete sarva iṃdrasyājñayā tadupabhogayogyaṃ rayiṃ dhanaṃ*
> *rakṣaṃti ‖ niṣpidhaḥ | ṣidhu gatyāṃ | kvip | saṃhitāyāṃ nisaḥ sakāreṇeṇo vyavadhānaṃ*
> *chāṃdasatvādanādṛtyopasargātsunotītyādinā ṣatvaṃ | nisaḥ sakārasya ṣṭunā ṣṭuriti*
> *ṣatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Among mortals, the injunctions (niṣpidhaḥ) of Indra are many and of various kinds, through beneficial teachings and the like. A mantra on Indra as ruler: उक्धमिंद्राय शंस्यं वर्धनं पुरुनिष्ठिधे (*ukdhamiṃdrāya śaṃsyaṃ*

vardhanaṃ puruniṣṭhidhe) (Ṛg. 1-10-5). Likewise the earth holds many treasures within for that ruling Indra. Further, the heavens, the plants, the waters, the jīrayaḥ (men, who are worn out) and the forests (trees): all these, by Indra's command, guard the wealth fit for his enjoyment. The rest is grammar on niṣpidhaḥ.

Word-to-word meaning

मर्त्येषु (*martyeṣu*)	among men
अस्य (*asya*)	of this Indra
निषिधः (*niṣidhaḥ*)	teachings in the form of grace
पूर्वीः (*pūrvīḥ*)	are many
इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)	for this Indra, the teacher
पृथिवी (*pṛthivī*)	the earth
पुरु (*puru*)	many
वसूनि (*vasūni*)	treasures
भिभर्ति (*bhibharti*)	holds
द्यावः (*dyāvaḥ*)	the heavens
ओषधीः (*oṣadhīḥ*)	the plants
उत (*uta*)	and
आपः (*āpaḥ*)	the waters
जीरयः (*jīrayaḥ*)	men
वनानि (*vanāni*)	trees
रयिं (*rayiṃ*)	wealth
रक्षंति (*rakṣaṃti*)	guard

Gist

The teachings of this Indra, in the form of grace, are many among men. For this Indra, the teacher, the earth holds many treasures. The heavens, the plants, the waters, men and the trees also keep wealth guarded for him.

English translation

Many are his prohibitions (against evil enjoined) to men : many are the treasures that the earth enshrines : for Indra the heavens, the plants, the waters, men and priests, preserve their riches.

Special Topics

पूर्वीः अस्य निष्पिधः मर्त्येषु (*pūrvīḥ asya niṣpidhaḥ martyeṣu*)- अनुशासनानि हितोपदेशादिभिः नानाप्रकाराणि भवंति (*anuśāsanāni hitopadeśādibhiḥ nānāprakārāṇi bhavaṃti*). Indra's injunctions or rules are many with regard to men, in the form of beneficial teaching. Here the commentator explains the word niṣpidhaḥ as injunctions, rules; that is, to punish and restrain the wicked is called anuśāsana. With this meaning—

[The sentence continues from the previous page:] The commentator cites as an example the Ṛk

उक्कमिंद्राय शंस्यं वर्धनं पुरुनिष्पिधे । (*ukkamiṃdrāya śaṃsyaṃ vardhanaṃ puruniṣpidhe |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-10-5).

For the word पुरुनिष्पिधे (*puruniṣpidhe*) in this Ṛk he explains बहूनां शत्रूणां निषेधकारिणे (*bahūnāṃ śatrūṇāṃ niṣedhakāriṇe*), that is, "to him who defeats many enemies and keeps them under restraint". It is therefore indicated that the ordinances called niṣpidha, namely the punishing of the wicked and the protecting of the good, are carried out by Indra.

पुरु वसूनि (*puru vasūni*) ...... वनानि (*vanāni*)—In accordance with the command of such a supremely glorious Indra, the earth bears wealth of many kinds in the form of plants and the like; the heaven, the herbs, the waters and the trees all guard, by Indra's command, the wealth in each of them, that is, the essential, excellent things, for Indra's enjoyment. This is the main purport of the Ṛk.

Ṛk 6

Samhitā-pāṭha

तुभ्यं॒ ब्रह्मा॑णि॒ गिर॑ इन्द्र॒ तुभ्यं॑ स॒त्रा द॑धिरे हरिवो जु॒षस्व॑ ।
बो॒ध्या॒३॒॑पिरव॑सो॒ नूत॑नस्य॒ सखे॑ वसो जरि॒तृभ्यो॒ वयो॑ धाः ॥ ६ ॥

> *tubhyaṃ brahmāṇi gira indra tubhyaṃ satrā dadhire harivo juṣasva |*
> *bodhyāpiravaso nūtanasya sakhe vaso jaritṛbhyo vayo dhāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तुभ्यं । ब्रह्माणि । गिरः । इंद्र । तुभ्यं । सत्रा । दधिरे । हरिऽवः । जुषस्व ।
> बोधि । आपिः । अवसः । नूतनस्य । सखे । वसो इति । जरितृभ्यः । वयः । धाः । ६ ॥

> *tubhyaṃ | brahmāṇi | giraḥ | iṃdra | tubhyaṃ | satrā | dadhire | hari 'vaḥ | juṣasva |*
> *bodhi | āpiḥ | avasaḥ | nūtanasya | sakhe | vaso iti | jaritṛbhyaḥ | vayaḥ | dhāḥ | 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे हरिवोऽश्ववन्निंद्र तुभ्यं त्वदर्थं ब्रह्माणि स्तोत्राणि तथा तुभ्यं गिरः
> शास्त्राणि च सत्ता सत्यमेव दधिरे । ऋत्विजो धारयंति । तानि जुषस्व । सेवस्व । हे
> वसो सर्वस्य वासयितः सखे सखिभूत हे इंद्र आपिर्वाप्तस्त्वं नूतनस्य नवतरमवसोऽन्नलक्षणं
> हविर्भोधि । त्वदर्थं दीयमानं जानीहि । आतस्त्वं जरितृभ्यः
> स्तोतृभ्योऽस्मभ्यं वयोऽन्नं धाः । देहि ॥ तुभ्यं । जयि चेत्याद्युदात्तत्वं। जुषस्व।
> जुषी प्रीतिसेवनयोरित्यस्य लोटि रूपं । वाक्यभेदादनिघातः । बोधि । बुध अवगमन इत्यस्य
> लोटि वा छंदसीति हेर्विकल्पेन जित्वादत्र पित्त्वाद्गुणः । हुझल्फो
> हेर्धिरिति ध्यादेशः । जित्वादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *he harivo 'śvavanniṃdra tubhyaṃ tvadarthaṃ brahmāṇi stotrāṇi tathā tubhyaṃ giraḥ*
> *śāstrāṇi ca sattā satyameva dadhire | ṛtvijo dhārayaṃti | tāni juṣasva | sevasva | he*

> *vaso sarvasya vāsayitaḥ sakhe sakhibhūta he iṃdra āpirvāptastvaṃ nūtanasya navataramavaso 'nnalakṣaṇaṃ havirbhodhi | tvadarthaṃ dīyamānaṃ jānīhi | ātastvaṃ jaritṛbhyaḥ*
> *stotṛbhyo 'smabhyaṃ vayo 'nnaṃ dhāḥ | dehi || tubhyaṃ | jayi cetyādyudāttatvaṃ| juṣasva|*
> *juṣī prītisevanayorityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | vākyabhedādanighātaḥ | bodhi | budha avagamana ityasya loṭi vā chaṃdasīti hervikalpena jitvādatra pittvādguṇaḥ | hujhalpho*
> *herdhiriti dhyādeśaḥ | jitvādaṃtodāttaḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, हरिवः (*harivaḥ*), possessor of horses: for you the Brahmans (stotras, hymns of praise) and for you the "gir" (śāstras, recitations) the priests truly hold up; enjoy them, accept them. O वसो (*vaso*), he who causes all to dwell, O friend, O Indra, who are all-pervading: know that the newest food, the oblation in the form of अवसः (*avasaḥ*) (food), is being given for you. Therefore give food to us, the singers who praise you.?64

Word-to-word meaning

- हरिवे (*harive*)—O one yoked with horses
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—for you alone
- ब्रह्माणि (*brahmāṇi*)—the hymns of praise
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—for you alone
- गिरः (*giraḥ*)—the śastra-mantras
- सत्रा (*satrā*)—truly
- दधिरे (*dadhire*)—(the priests) have held
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—(them) enjoy
- वसो (*vaso*)—O maker of dwelling-places
- सखी (*sakhī*)—O Indra, who are a friend
- आपि (*āpi*)—you, who are all-pervading
- नूतनस्य (*nūtanasya*)—(though) new
- अवसः (*avasaḥ*)—the food, which is in the form of oblation
- बोधि (*bodhi*)—know
- जरितृभ्यः (*jaritṛbhyaḥ*)—to us, the praisers

- वयः (*vayaḥ*)—food
- धाः (*dhāḥ*)—give

Gist

O Indra, yoked with horses, the priests have held up hymns of praise and śastra-mantras for you alone. Enjoy them. O Indra, maker of dwelling-places and friend, you who are all-pervading, know the food, new and in the form of oblation, accept it, and give us, who praise you, the food that we desire.

English translation

To you, Indra, (the pious) address prayers, and praises, and sacrifices : accept them, lord of horses : giver of dwellings, friend (of man), you are the pervader (of all things), partake of this present oblations, and grant food to the worshippers.

Special Topics

हरिव: (*hariva:*)—अश्ववन्निंद्र । (*aśvavannimḍra* |) Indra's horses are named "Hari" (Ni. 2-28). Indra is addressed by the word हरिवः (*harivaḥ*) as "O Indra, possessor of such horses".

तुभ्यं ब्रह्माणि तुभ्यं गिरः सत्रा दधिरे जुषस्व (*tubhyaṃ brahmāṇi tubhyaṃ giraḥ satrā dadhire juṣasva*)—O Indra, the priests are reciting hymns of praise and words of praise for you. "Enjoy it" means "hear it and be pleased"; this is the main purport. Here the word तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*) is recited twice in order to indicate the great affection of the worshipper for Indra.

सखे वसो आपि नूतनस्य अवसः बोधि (*sakhe vaso āpi nūtanasya avasaḥ bodhi*) —सर्वस्य वासयितः सखिभूत हे इंद्र व्याप्तस्तं नूतनस्य अन्नलक्षणं हविः त्वदर्थं दीयमानं जानीहि । (*sarvasya vāsayitaḥ sakhibhūta he iṃdra vyāptastaṃ nūtanasya annalakṣaṇaṃ haviḥ tvadarthaṃ dīyamānaṃ jānīhi* |) O Indra, who provide a dwelling-place for all and are beneficent like a friend, you who are all-pervading, know that the oblation in the form of food, newly prepared by us just now to be offered to you, is made ready for you alone.

जरितृभ्यः वयः धाः (*jaritṛbhyaḥ vayaḥ dhāḥ*)—स्तोतृभ्योऽस्मभ्यमन्नं वेहि । (*stotṛbhyo 'smabhyamannaṃ vehi* |) Favour us, who sing praise, by giving अत्मनन्नु (*atmanannu*).[?65] The words अवः (*avaḥ*) and वयः (*vayaḥ*) are read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9).

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ मरुत्व इ॒ह पा॑हि॒ सोम॒ं यथा॑ शार्या॒ते अपि॑बः सु॒तस्य॑ ।
तव॒ प्रणी॑ती॒ तव॑ शू॒र शर्म॒न्ना वि॑वासन्ति क॒वय॑ः सुय॒ज्ञाः ॥ ७ ॥

> *indra marutva iha pāhi somaṃ yathā śāryāte apibaḥ sutasya |*
> *tava praṇītī tava śūra śarmannā vivāsanti kavayaḥ suyajñāḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । मरुत्वः । इह । पाहि । सोमं । यथा । शार्याते । अपिबः । सुतस्य ।
> तव । प्रणीती । तव । शूर । शर्मन् । आ । विवासंति । कवयः । सुयज्ञाः ॥ ७ ॥

> *iṃdra | marutvaḥ | iha | pāhi | somaṃ | yathā | śāryāte | apibaḥ | sutasya |*
> *tava | praṇītī | tava | śūra | śarman | ā | vivāsaṃti | kavayaḥ | suyajñāḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मरुत्वो मरुद्भिस्तद्वन् हे इंद्र त्वमिहास्मदीये यज्ञ अगत्य सोमं पाहि । पिब । यथा त्वं पूर्वं शार्याते शर्यातिः पुत्रे तस्मिन्नाजनि यज्ञं कुर्वाणे सुतस्याभिषुतं सोममपिबः तथात्रापि पिबेत्यर्थः । इंद्रः शार्यातस्य यज्ञे सोमरसानपिबदित्येषोऽर्थः कौषीतके स्पष्टमुक्तः । तथा मंत्रवर्णश्च । आ स्मा रथं वृषपाणेषु तिष्ठसि शार्यातस्य प्रकृता येषु मंदसे । ऋग्वे. १–५१–१२ । इति । हे शूरेंद्र तव संबंधिनि शर्मन् शर्मणि निर्बाधस्थाने स्थिताः सुयज्ञाः सुष्टु कृतयज्ञाः कवयो मेधाविनो यजमानाः प्रणीती तव हविषां प्रणयनेन प्रापणेन आ समंताद्विवासंति । त्वामेव परिचरंति । विवासतिः परिचरणकर्मा ॥

> शार्यते । शर्यातिरयमित्यर्थे तस्येदमित्यण् प्रत्ययः । अपिबः । यथायोगादनिघातः ।
> अडागमस्वरः । प्रणीती । नयतेभार्वे क्तिन् । तादौ च निति कृतीति गतेः
> प्रकृतिश्वरत्वं । सुपां सुलुगिति तृतीयायाः सवर्णदीर्घः । उपसर्गादसमासेऽपि
> णत्वं ॥

> *he marutvo marudbhistadvan he iṃdra tvamihāsmadīye yajña agatya somaṃ*
> *pāhi | piba | yathā tvaṃ pūrvaṃ śāryāte śaryāteḥ putre tasminnājani yajñaṃ*
> *kurvāṇe sutasyābhiṣutaṃ somamapibaḥ tathātrāpi pibetyarthaḥ | iṃdra: śāryātasya*
> *yajñe somarasānapibadityeṣo 'rthaḥ kauṣītake spaṣṭamuktaḥ | tathā maṃtravarṇaśca |*
> *ā smā rathaṃ vṛṣapāṇeṣu tiṣṭhasi śāryātasya prakṛtā yeṣu maṃdase | ṛgve. 1-51-12*
> *| iti | he śūreṃdra tava saṃbaṃdhini śarman śarmaṇi nirbādhasthāne sthitāḥ suyajñāḥ*
> *suṣṭu kṛtayajñāḥ kavayo medhāvino yajamānāḥ praṇītī tava haviṣāṃ praṇayanena*
> *prāpaṇena ā samaṃtādvivāsaṃti | tvāmeva paricaraṃti | vivāsatiḥ paricaraṇakarmā ‖*
> *śāryate | śaryāterayamityarthe tasyedamityaṇ pratyayaḥ | apibaḥ |*
> *yathāyogādanighātaḥ | aḍāgamasvaraḥ | praṇītī | nayatebhārvè ktin | tādau ca niti kṛtīti gateḥ*
> *prakṛtiśvaratvaṃ | supāṃ sulugiti tṛtīyāyāḥ savarṇadīrghaḥ | upasargādasamāse 'pi*
> *ṇatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

O मरुत्वः (*marutvaḥ*), Indra accompanied by the Maruts, come to this our sacrifice and drink the soma; as you formerly drank the pressed soma when Śāryāta, the son of Śaryāti, was performing a sacrifice, so drink here also. That Indra drank the soma-juices at Śāryāta's sacrifice is stated clearly in the Kauṣītaki; and there is a mantra text to the same effect: आ स्मा रथं वृषपाणेषु तिष्ठसि शार्यातस्य प्रकृता येषु मंदसे । (*ā smā rathaṃ vṛṣapāṇeṣu tiṣṭhasi śāryātasya prakṛtā yeṣu maṃdase |*) (Ṛgve. 1-51-12)[?66]. O hero Indra, the wise sacrificers who have performed their sacrifice well, abiding in your own shelter, a place free of obstruction, serve you all around by bringing you the oblations; they attend on you alone. विवासति (*vivāsati*) is a word of the sense of attendance.

Word-to-word meaning

- मदुत्वः (*madutvaḥ*)—accompanied by the Maruts
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- यथा (*yathā*)—in the way in which
- शार्यते (*śāryate*)—at the sacrifice of the son of Śaryāta[?67]
- सुतस्य (*sutasya*)—the pressed soma
- अपिबः (*apibaḥ*)—you drank, even so
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrificial rite
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the soma-juice
- पाहि (*pāhi*)—drink
- शूर (*śūra*)—O valiant Indra
- तव (*tava*)—pertaining to your worship
- शर्मन् (*śarman*)—those engaged in the rites
- सुयज्ञाः (*suyajñāḥ*)—excellent sacrificers
- कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)—wise sacrificers
- तव (*tava*)—to you
- प्रणीती (*praṇītī*)—by offering the oblation
- आ विवासंति (*ā vivāsaṃti*)—they worship (you) all around

Gist

O Indra, accompanied by the Maruts, as you formerly drank the pressed soma-juice at the sacrifice of Śaryāta's son, so drink at this sacrificial rite also the soma that is offered. O valiant Indra, the sacrificers, who are engaged in the rites that are the object of your worship, who are excellent performers of sacrifice and wise, serve you all around by offering the oblation.

English translation

Indra, accompanied by the Maruts, drink the soma at this ceremony as you have drunk of the libation of the son of Sharyati : your far-seeing and devout worshippers, being in security, adore you through their offerings

Special Topics

मरुत्वः (*marutvaḥ*)—मरुद्भिस्तद्वन् । (*marudbhistadvan* |) The meaning is "O Indra, together with the Marut deities". Here Indra is prayed to come with the Marut deities to our sacrificial ground and drink the soma.

यथा शार्यते अपिबः सुतस्य (*yathā śāryāte apibaḥ sutasya*)—O Indra, as you formerly came to the sacrifice performed by the son of one named Śaryāti and drank soma, so come to our sacrificial ground also and drink the soma; thus the seer prays. The commentator says that the matter of Indra's drinking soma at the sacrifice of Śaryāti's son is stated clearly in the Kauṣītakī Brāhmaṇa, and as an example he gives the Ṛk that mentions this matter in the Ṛgveda also:

आ स्मा रथं वृषपाणेषु तिष्ठसि शार्यातस्य प्रभृता येषु मंदसे । (*ā smā ratham vṛṣapāṇeṣu tiṣṭhasi śāryātasya prabhṛtā yeṣu maṃdase* |)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-51-12).

Śaryāti was a royal seer. His son is customarily called Śāryāta. Formerly, when this Śāryāta performed a sacrifice, the great sage Cyavana, born in the Bhṛgu lineage, gave the share of the oblation first to the Aśvin deities. Indra then became greatly angry. Śāryāta, knowing this, praised Indra in various ways and pleased him, prepared the soma-juice by the rites of pressing and the like, and offered that purified soma to Indra.

Indra, satisfied, drank the soma-juice to his heart's content at Śāryāta's sacrifice; so runs the legend. The seer describes that very thing here. The name of this Śāryāta is indicated in the present Ṛk, in Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-51-12, in Ai. Brā. 4-32-7, Śa. Brā. 4-1-5-1, the Jaiminīya Brāhmaṇa 3-121 and other places.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स वा॑वशा॒न इ॒ह पा॑हि॒ सोमं॑ म॒रुद्भि॑रिन्द्र॒ सखि॑भिः सु॒तं न॑ः ।
जा॒तं यत्त्वा॒ परि॑ दे॒वा अभू॑षन्म॒हे भरा॑य पुरुहू॒त विश्वे॑ ॥ ८ ॥

> *sa vāvaśāna iha pāhi somaṃ marudbhirindra sakhibhiḥ sutaṃ naḥ |*
> *jātaṃ yattvā pari devā abhūṣanmahe bharāya puruhūta viśve ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । वावशानः । इह । पाहि । सोमं । मरुत्भिः । इंद्र । सखिभिः । सुतं । नः ।
> जातं । यत् । त्वा । परि । देवाः । अभूषन् । महे । भराय । पुरुहूत । विश्वे ॥

> *saḥ | vāvaśānaḥ | iha | pāhi | somaṃ | marutbhiḥ | iṃdra | sakhibhiḥ | sutaṃ | naḥ |*
> *jātaṃ | yat | tvā | pari | devāḥ | abhūṣan | mahe | bharāya | puruhūta | viśve ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वावशानः सोमं कामयमानः स तादृशस्त्वं सखिभिः समानख्यानैर्मरुद्भिः सह नोऽस्मत्संबंधिनीहास्मिन्यज्ञे सुतमभिषुतं सोमं पाहि । पिब ।
> हे पुरुहूत पुरुभिराहूतेंद्र जातं पानेन प्रबलं संपन्नं यत् यं त्वां विश्वे सर्वे देवा महे महते भराय । ह्रियंते योधानामायुंष्यत्रेति भरः संग्रामः । तस्मै संग्रामाय पर्यभूषन् । सर्वतोऽलमकुर्वन् ॥ वावशानः । वशेर्यज् लुकि चानशि रूपं । चित्तादंतोदात्तः । अभूषन् । भूष अलंकारे । भूवादिः । लजि रूपं । यद्योगादनिघातः । भराय । हृञ् हरणे। अधिकरणे घः । हृग्रहोर्भश्चंदसीति हकारस्य भकारः । वृषादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he iṃdra vāvaśānaḥ somaṃ kāmayamānaḥ sa tādṛśastvaṃ sakhibhiḥ samānakhyānairmarudbhiḥ saha no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhinīhāsminyajñe sutamabhiṣutaṃ somaṃ pāhi | piba |*
> *he puruhūta purubhirāhūteṃdra jātaṃ pānena prabalaṃ saṃpannaṃ*

> *yat yaṃ tvāṃ viśve*
> *sarvè devā mahe mahate bharāya | hriyaṃte yodhānāmāyuṃṣyatreti bharaḥ*
> *saṃgrāmaḥ | tasmai saṃgrāmāya paryabhūṣan | sarvato 'lamakurvan ‖ vāvaśānaḥ |*
> *vaśeryaj luki cānaśi rūpaṃ | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | abhūṣan | bhūṣa alaṃkāre |*
> *bhūvādiḥ | laji rūpaṃ | yadyogādanighātaḥ | bharāya | hṛñ haraṇe| adhikaraṇe ghaḥ |*
> *hṛgrahorbhaścaṃdasīti hakārasya bhakāraḥ | vṛṣāditvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, वावशानः (*vāvaśānaḥ*), desirous of soma: such as you are, with the Maruts, who are your friends, of the same name, drink the soma pressed for us here, at this our sacrifice. O पुरुहूत (*puruhūta*), invoked by many, Indra, born, made strong and complete by drinking: you whom all the gods equipped for the great भराय (*bharāya*). भरः (*bharaḥ*) is battle, because the lives of warriors are carried off in it (ह्रियंते योधानामायुंष्यत्रेति (*hriyaṃte yodhānāmāyuṃṣyatreti*)); for that battle they adorned you on all sides.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुहूत (*puruhūta*)—O one invoked by many
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- जातं (*jātaṃ*)—you who, drinking soma as soon as you were born, became full of strength
- यत् त्वा (*yat tvā*)—whom you
- विश्वे देवाः (*viśve devāḥ*)—all the gods
- महे (*mahe*)—great
- भराय (*bharāya*)—for the work of battle
- परि अभूषन् (*pari abhūṣan*)—made ready
- स (*sa*)—such as you are
- वावशानः (*vāvaśānaḥ*)—desirous of drinking soma
- सखिभिः (*sakhibhiḥ*)—your friends
- मरुद्भिः (*marudbhiḥ*)—with the Maruts
- नः (*naḥ*)—our

- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrifice
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—soma
- पाहि (*pāhi*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, invoked by many, whom all the gods made ready for the great work of battle, you who became full of strength by drinking soma as soon as you were born: such as you are, desirous of drinking soma, drink together with the Maruts, your friends, the soma pressed at this our sacrifice.

English translation

Indra, yoo are gratified by the beverage, drink the Soma that has been effused by us, together with your friends, the Maruts, at this ceremony: you who are invoked of many, and whom all the gods equipped as soon as born for the great battle (with the Asuras).

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the seer describes that Indra is requested to come to the sacrificial ground with his friends, the Marut deities, and drink soma, and that all the gods served Indra, made strong by that soma-drinking, in order to win victory in battle.

The eternal companionship and friendship of Indra and the Maruts, the relation of king and subjects between them, the offering of oblations in the principal sacrificial acts to Indra accompanied by the Maruts, and the help the Maruts gave Indra when he fought with the demon Vṛtra are praised in many places in the Saṃhitās and the Brāhmaṇas. A legend telling how Indra, joining the Maruts, stood apart from the other gods is told in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa[?68]. Besides, it is said in many places that Indra is the king and the Maruts the subjects. It is also indicated that Indra's valour increased through the help of the Maruts. Because of such a close relation and companionship, the custom of offering oblations addressed to Indra and the Maruts together is seen in the Śrutis.

स नो मरुद्भिर्वृषभ श्रवो धा उग्र उग्रेभिः स्थविरः सहोदाः । (*sa no marudbhirvṛṣabha śravo dhā ugra ugrebhiḥ sthaviraḥ sahodāḥ |*)

(Ya Saṃ. 1-171-5)[?69]

...in ṛks such as this there is, for Indra and the Maruts together, a joint invocation and an offering of the oblation.

And in the Bṛhaddevatā as well: मरुद्भिः सह यत्रेंद्रो मरुत्वांस्तत्र सोऽभवत् । (*marudbhiḥ saha yatreṃdro marutvāṃstatra so 'bhavat |*) (Bṛ. De. 4-56). This gives an account of the companionship of Indra and the Maruts.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒प्तूर्ये॑ मरुत आ॒पिरे॒षोऽमं॑न्द॒न्निन्द्र॒मनु॒ दाति॑वाराः ।
तेभिः॑ सा॒कं पि॑बतु वृत्रखा॒दः सु॒तं सोमं॑ दा॒शुषः॑ स्वे स॒धस्थे॑ ॥ ९ ॥

> *aptūrye maruta āpireṣo 'mandannindramanu dātivārāḥ |*
> *tebhiḥ sākaṃ pibatu vṛtrakhādaḥ sutaṃ somaṃ dāśuṣaḥ sve sadhasthe || 9 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्त्तूर्ये । मरुतः । अपिः । एषः । अमंदन् । इंद्रं । अनु । दाशिवाराः ।
> तेभिः साकं । पिबतु । वृत्रखादः । सुतं । सोमं । दाशुषः । स्वे । सधस्थे ॥ ९ ॥

> *asttūrye | marutaḥ | apiḥ | eṣaḥ | amaṃdan | iṃdraṃ | anu | dāśivārāḥ |*
> *tebhiḥ sākaṃ | pibatu | vṛtrakhādaḥ | sutaṃ | somaṃ | dāśuṣaḥ | sve | sadhasthe || 9 ||*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मरुतो य एष इंद्रोऽपूर्येऽपां प्रेरण आपिर्युष्माकं सखा सन् वर्तते दाशिवाराः । वारो वरणेयं बलं धनं वा । दत्तबला दत्तधना वा ते मरुतस्तमिंद्रमन्वमंदन् । अहृष्यन् । वृत्रखादो वृत्रस्य हिंसकः स इंद्रस्तेभिस्मैर्मरुद्भिः साकं

> दाशुषो हविर्दत्तवतो यजमानस्य स्वे स्वकीये सधस्थे । सह
> तिष्ठंत्यस्मिन्निति सधस्थं गृहं । तस्मिन् सुतमभिषुतं सोमं पिबतु ॥ अपूर्ये ।
> तूरी त्वराहिंसयोरित्यस्मादघ्न्यादयश्चेति यत्पत्ययः । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तः । समासे
> कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः । अमंदन् । मदि स्तुत्यादिषु । परस्मैपदी ।
> पादादित्वादनिघातः । वृत्रखादः । खादृ भक्षणे । कर्मण्यण् । दाशुषः । दाश्व दान
> इत्यस्य क्वसौ दाश्वान्साह्वान्मिढ्वांश्चेति द्विर्वचनाद्यभावः । वसोः संप्रसारणं ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । सधस्थे । सध मादस्थयोश्छंदसीति सहस्य सधादेशः ॥

> *he maruto ya eṣa iṃdro 'pūrye 'pāṃ preraṇa āpiryuṣmākaṃ sakhā*
> *san vartate dāśivārāḥ | vāro varaṇeyaṃ balaṃ dhanaṃ vā | dattabalā*
> *dattadhanā vā te*
> *marutastamiṃdramanvamaṃdan | ahṛṣyan | vṛtrakhādo vṛtrasya*
> *hiṃsakaḥ sa iṃdrastebhismairmaruddhiḥ sākaṃ dāśuṣo havirdattavato*
> *yajamānasya sve svakīye sadhasthe | saha*
> *tiṣṭhaṃtyasminniti sadhasthaṃ gṛhaṃ | tasmin sutamabhiṣutaṃ somaṃ*
> *pibatu ‖ apūrye |*
> *tūrī tvarāhiṃsayorityasmādaghnyādayaśceti yatpatyayaḥ | yato 'nāva*
> *ityādyudāttaḥ | samāse kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ | amaṃdan | madi*
> *stutyādiṣu | parasmaipadī |*
> *pādāditvādanighātaḥ | vṛtrakhādaḥ | khādṛ bhakṣaṇe | karmaṇyaṇ |*
> *dāśuṣaḥ | dāśva dāna*
> *ityasya kvasau dāśvānsāhvānniḍhvāṃśceti dvirvacanādyabhāvaḥ |*
> *vasoḥ saṃprasāraṇaṃ |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ | sadhasthe | sadha mādasthayośṛṃdasīti sahasya*
> *sadhādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Maruts, this Indra who is your friend (āpi) in the apūrya, the sending forth of the waters, was gladdened after by those Maruts who are दाशिवाराः (*dāśivārāḥ*)." Vāra means choice, strength or wealth; so the dāśivārāḥ are those who have given strength or given wealth. The Maruts gladdened that Indra. Vṛtrakhāda is the slayer of Vṛtra. Let that Indra, together with those Maruts, drink the soma pressed in the own abode (sadhastha) of the sacrificer who has given the oblation. A sadhastha is a house, since people stand together (saha tiṣṭhanti) in it. The remainder of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—O Maruts
- एषः (*eṣaḥ*)—this Indra
- अप्त्यो (*aptyo*)—at the time of pouring rain
- आपि (*āpi*)—is your friend
- दातिवाराः (*dātivārāḥ*)—(to him) those Maruts, the providers of strength
- इंद्रं अनु (*iṃdraṃ anu*)—to Indra
- अमंदन् (*amaṃdan*)—became givers of delight
- वृत्रखादः (*vṛtrakhādaḥ*)—Indra, the slayer of Vṛtra
- तेभिः साकं (*tebhiḥ sākaṃ*)—together with those Maruts
- दाशुषः (*dāśuṣaḥ*)—of the sacrificer who offers the oblation
- स्वे सधस्थे (*sve sadhasthe*)—in his own sacrificial house
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the soma
- पिबतु (*pibatu*)—let him drink

Gist

O Maruts, this Indra is your friend at the time of pouring rain. Those Maruts, the providers of strength to him, became givers of delight to Indra. Let Indra, the slayer of Vṛtra, together with those Maruts, drink the soma pressed in the own sacrificial house of the sacrificer who offers the oblation.

English translation

Maruts, this is your friend for sending of the waters: they (the Maruts), the givers of strength, have yielded Indra gratification: may the devourer of Vritra drink with them the libation offered by the worshipper in his own abode.

Special Topics

The friendly feeling and companionship of Indra and the Maruts were already subtly set out in the preceding ṛk. This ṛk tells that Indra helps the Marut deities even in the pouring of rain. The help rendered to the Maruts is this: Indra strikes with the thunderbolt the demon Vṛtra, who has held back the rain from falling, and so assists the pouring of the rain. The seer prays that Indra come with such Marut deities and drink soma in the sacrificial house of the sacrificer.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒दं ह्यन्वोज॑सा सु॒तं रा॑धानां पते ।
पिबा॒ त्व१॒॑स्य गि॑र्वणः ॥ १० ॥

> *idaṃ hyanvojasā sutaṃ rādhānāṃ pate |*
> *pibā tvasya girvaṇaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इदं । हि । अनु । ओजसा । सुतं । राधानां । पते ।
> पिब । तु । अस्य । गिर्वणः ॥ १० ॥

> *idaṃ | hi | anu | ojasā | sutaṃ | rādhānāṃ | pate |*
> *piba | tu | asya | girvaṇaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे राधानां पते धनानां स्वामिन् गिर्वणो गीर्भिः स्तुतिभिर्वननीय हे
> इंद्र इदमनु अनेनानुक्रमेण । उद्देशानुक्रमेणेत्यर्थः । ओजसा बलेन ग्रावभिः
> सुतमभिषुतं सोमं तु क्षिप्रं पिब हि ॥

> *he rādhānāṃ pate dhanānāṃ svāmin girvaṇo gīrbhiḥ stutibhirvananīya he*
> *iṃdra idamanu anenānukrameṇa | uddeśānukrameṇetyarthaḥ | ojasā balena grāvabhiḥ*
> *sutamabhiṣutaṃ somaṃ tu kṣipraṃ piba hi ‖*

Summary

"O lord of riches (rādhas), O Indra, who art to be won (vananīya) by songs (gīrbhiḥ), i.e. by praises: इदमनु (*idamanu*) means 'in this sequence', that is, in the sequence of the purpose. With strength (ojas), i.e. with the pressing-stones, drink quickly this soma that has been pressed."

Word-to-word meaning

- राधानां (*rādhānāṃ*)—of riches
- पते (*pate*)—O lord
- गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—O Indra, who art praised with songs
- इदं अनु (*idaṃ anu*)—in sequence of the purpose
- ओजसा (*ojasā*)—with the powerful stones
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—crushed and pressed
- अस्य (*asya*)—this soma
- तु (*tu*)—quickly
- पिब हि (*piba hi*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, lord of riches, praised with songs: in the sequence of the purpose, drink quickly this soma pressed with the powerful stones.

English translation

Lord of riches, entitled to praise, this libation has been effused agreeably to (our) strength : drink of it quickly.

Special Topics

गिर्वणः (*girvaṇaḥ*)—गीर्भिर्वननीयः (*gīrbhirvananīyaḥ*). He who is approached with words of praise; that is, when he is invoked with hymns and the like, Indra comes to the sacrificial ground to favour them and drinks the soma. This is the meaning.

ओजसा सुतं (*ojasā sutaṃ*)—बलेन ग्रावभिः अभिषुतं सोमं (*balena grāvabhiḥ abhiṣutaṃ somaṃ*). Since, when the soma plants are crushed with stones to take out the juice, they have to be crushed with the application of force, the expression ओजसा सुतं (*ojasā sutaṃ*) is appropriate.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्ते॒ अनुं॑ स्व॒धामसं॑त्सु॒ते नि यं॑च्छ त॒न्वं॑म् ।
स त्वा॑ ममत्तु सो॒म्यम् ॥ ११ ॥

> *yaste anu svadhāmasatsute ni yaccha tanvam |*
> *sa tvā mamattu somyam ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । ते । अनु । स्वधां । असत् । सुते । नि । यच्छ । तन्नं ।
> सः । त्वा । ममत्तु । सोम्यं ॥ ११ ॥

> *yaḥ | te | anu | svadhāṃ | asat | sute | ni | yaccha | tannaṃ |*
> *saḥ | tvā | mamattu | somyaṃ ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वदर्थं यः सोमः स्वधामन्नमनु अनुसृत्य ग्रावभिरभिषुतोऽसत् सुते तस्मिन् सोमे तन्नं स्वकीयं शरीरं नि यच्छ । प्रेरय । स सोमः
> सोम्यं सोमार्हं त्वा त्वां ममत्तु । मादयातु ॥ असत् । अस्तेर्लेट्यडागमे
> रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra tvadarthaṃ yaḥ somaḥ svadhāmannamanu anusṛtya grāvabhirabhiṣuto 'sat sute tasmin some tannaṃ svakīyaṃ śarīraṃ ni yaccha | preraya | sa somaḥ*
> *somyaṃ somārhaṃ tvā tvāṃ mamattu | mādayātu ‖ asat | asterleṭyaḍāgame*
> *rūpaṃ | yadvattayogādanighātaḥ | āgamasyānudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, the soma that, for thee, has been pressed with the stones in accordance with svadhā (food) — in that pressed soma नि यच्छ (*ni yaccha*) thy own body, that is, direct it. Let that soma gladden thee, who art worthy of soma." The rest of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- ते (*te*)—for thee
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the soma which
- स्वधां अनु (*svadhāṃ anu*)—pressed in accordance with the contest
- असत् (*asat*)—is ready
- सुते (*sute*)—in this pressed soma
- तन्नं (*tannaṃ*)—thy body
- नि यच्छ (*ni yaccha*)—rouse up
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same soma
- सोम्यं (*somyaṃ*)—worthy of the soma-drink
- त्वा (*tvā*)—thee
- ममत्तु (*mamattu*)—let it gladden

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Gist

O Indra, the soma that has been pressed for thee in accordance with the contest and made ready: in this pressed, ready soma rouse up thy body. Let that same soma gladden thee, who art worthy of the soma-drink.

English translation

Invigorate your body with the soma that has been poured out as food for you: may it exhilarate you, delighting in the Soma draught.

Special Topics

स्वधां अनु (*svadhāṃ anu*)—The word svadhā is read among the names of food. The meaning is: O Indra, the soma juice that is fit to be consumed, standing in the place of food, as food for thee. Or else it may be understood that after the eating of food and the like, this soma juice has been prepared for drinking.

सुते नि यच्छ तन्वं (*sute ni yaccha tanvaṃ*)—When the soma juice is ready, direct thy body; that is, make thyself ready for drinking soma, or resolve to do so.

The seer prays that this soma juice that we have prepared may gladden thee, who art worthy of the soma-drink.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र ते॑ अश्नोतु कु॒क्ष्योः प्रेन्द्र॒ ब्रह्म॑णा॒ शिरः॑ ।
प्र बा॒हू शू॑र॒ राध॑से ॥ १२ ॥

> *pra te aśnotu kukṣyoḥ prendra brahmaṇā śiraḥ |*
> *pra bāhū śūra rādhase ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । ते । अश्नोतु । कुक्ष्योः । प्र । इंद्र । ब्रह्मणा । शिरः ।
> प्र । बार इति । शूर । राधसे ॥ १२ ॥

> *pra | te | aśnotu | kukṣyoḥ | pra | iṃdra | brahmaṇā | śiraḥ |*
> *pra | bāra iti | śūra | rādhase ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र स सोमस्ते तव कुक्षोः कुक्षेरुभयोः पार्श्वयोरुभौ पार्श्वा
> प्राश्नोतु । प्रकर्षण व्याप्नोति । तथा ब्रह्मणा स्तोत्रेण सहितः स सोमः शिरः
> शरीरं अवयवादिनावयवी लक्ष्यते । त्वच्छरीरं प्राश्नोतु । हे शूर इंद्र राधसे
> धनाय तव बाहू अपि प्राश्नोतु ॥ अश्नोतु । अशू व्याप्तावित्यस्य लोटि व्यत्ययेन
> परस्मैपदं । निघातः । कुक्षोः । उदात्तयणो हल्पूर्वादिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *he iṃdra sa somaste tava kukṣoḥ kukṣerubhayoḥ pārśvayorubhau pārśvā prāśnotu | prakarṣaṇa vyāpnoti | tathā brahmaṇā stotreṇa sahitaḥ sa somaḥ śiraḥ*
> *śarīraṃ avayavādināvayavī lakṣyate | tvaccharīraṃ prāśnotu | he śūra iṃdra rādhase*
> *dhanāya tava bāhū api prāśnotu ‖ aśnotu | aśū vyāptāvityasya loṭi vyatyayena*
> *parasmaipadaṃ | nighātaḥ | kukṣoḥ | udāttayaṇo halpūrvāditi vibhakterudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, let that soma pervade thy two sides of the belly (kukṣi), i.e. both flanks. Likewise let that soma, together with the brahman, i.e. the praise-song, pervade thy head (śiras); by the part the whole is indicated, so: let it pervade thy body. O hero Indra, for wealth (rādhas) let it pervade also thy arms." The rest of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same soma
- ते (*te*)—thy
- कुक्षोः (*kukṣoḥ*)—in both sides of the belly
- प्र अश्नोतु (*pra aśnotu*)—let it pervade fully
- ब्रह्मणा (*brahmaṇā*)—that soma accompanied by praise
- शिरः (*śiraḥ*)—thy body
- प्र (*pra*)—let it pervade fully
- शूर (*śūra*)—O valiant Indra
- राधसे (*rādhase*)—for the gain of wealth
- बाहू (*bāhū*)—in thy arms
- प्र (अश्नोतु) (*pra (aśnotu)*)—let it pervade fully

Gist

O Indra, let the soma offered to thee pervade fully both sides of thy belly, thy head, thy arms, and also thy whole body, for the gain of wealth for us.

English translation

May this libation, Indra, penetrate to your flanks ; may it, (aided) by prayer, reach your head; may it spread, hero, through your arms, (that they may distribute) wealth.

Special Topics

In this ṛk the seer expresses the wish: let the soma juice that we have prepared pervade well both parts of Indra's belly and the other parts of his body, especially the head and the arms, and cause him delight; and let Indra, delighted by that soma-drinking, bring us gain of wealth.

Sūkta 52 (Maṇḍala 3)

?71

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> धानावंतमित्यष्टर्चं चतुर्दशं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रम्यंद्रं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । धानावंतमष्टौ पूर्वार्धं गायत्रं षष्ठी जगतीति । आदितश्चतुस्रो
> गायत्र स्तृतीये धाना इति षष्ठी जगती शिष्टास्त्रिष्टुभः ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लिंगादवगंतव्यः । प्रातःसवनीयपुरोडाशस्यानुवाक्या धानावंतमित्याद्या । सूत्रितं
> च । धानावंतं करंभिणमिति प्रातःसवनेऽनुवाक्या । आ. ५–४ । इति ॥

> *dhānāvaṃtamityaṣṭarcaṃ caturdaśaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitramyaṃdraṃ | atreyamanukramaṇikā | dhānāvaṃtamaṣṭau pūrvārdhaṃ gāyatraṃ ṣaṣṭhī jagatīti | āditaścatusro*
> *gāyatra stṛtīye dhānā iti ṣaṣṭhī jagatī śiṣṭāstriṣṭubhaḥ ‖ sūktaviniyogo liṃgādavagaṃtavyaḥ | prātaḥsavanīyapuroḍāśasyānuvākyā dhānāvaṃtamityādyā | sūtritaṃ*
> *ca | dhānāvaṃtaṃ karaṃbhiṇamiti prātaḥsavane 'nuvākyā | ā. 5-4 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*) has eight ṛks and is the fourteenth sūkta; its seer is Viśvāmitra and its deity Indra. The Anukramaṇikā here: धानावंतमष्टौ पूर्वार्धं गायत्रं षष्ठी जगती (*dhānāvaṃtamaṣṭau pūrvārdhaṃ gāyatraṃ ṣaṣṭhī jagatī*). Explained: the first four ṛks are gāyatrī; the sixth, तृतीये धानाः (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ*), is jagatī; the remaining ones are triṣṭubh. The use (viniyoga) of the sūkta is to be learnt from the indication (liṅga) of the ṛks. The first ṛk, धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*), is the anuvākyā of the puroḍāśa of the morning pressing. It is also stated in the sūtra: धानावंतं करंभिणमिति प्रातःसवनेऽनुवाक्या (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ karaṃbhiṇamiti prātaḥsavane 'nuvākyā*) (Ā. 5-4).

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*) is the fourteenth sūkta in the fourth anuvāka. It has eight ṛks. Viśvāmitra is the seer of this sūkta; Indra is the deity. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said: धानावंतमष्टौ पूर्वार्धं गायत्रं षष्ठी जगती (*dhānāvaṃtamaṣṭau pūrvārdhaṃ gāyatraṃ ṣaṣṭhī jagatī*). The first four ṛks of this sūkta are in the gāyatrī metre; the sixth ṛk, तृतीये धानाः (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ*), is in the jagatī metre; the remaining three ṛks are in triṣṭubh metre. The use of the sūkta follows the meaning of the several ṛks. The first ṛk of this sūkta, धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*), is to be used as the anuvākyā mantra in the puroḍāśa oblation connected with the morning pressing; this is set forth by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra धानावंतं करंभिणमिति प्रातस्सवनेऽनुवाक्या (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ karaṃbhiṇamiti prātassavane 'nuvākyā*) (Ā. 5-4).

> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—५२
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—५२ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—१७, १८ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—८ ॥
> । ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ।
> । देवता—इंद्रः ।
> । छंदः—१–४. गायत्रि । ५, ६, ८ त्रिष्टुप् । ६ जगती ॥

> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—52*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—52 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—17, 18 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—8 ‖*
> *| ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ |*
> *| devatā—iṃdraḥ |*
> *| chaṃdaḥ—1-4. gāyatri | 5, 6, 8 triṣṭup | 6 jagatī ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

धा॒नाव॑न्तं कर॒म्भिण॑मपू॒पव॑न्तमु॒क्थिन॑म् ।
इन्द्र॑ प्रा॒तर्जु॑षस्व नः ॥ १ ॥

> *dhānāvantaṃ karambhiṇamapūpavantamukthinam |*
> *indra prātarjuṣasva naḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> धानावंतं । करंभिणं । अपूपवंतं । उक्किनं ।
> इंद्र । प्रातः । जुषस्व । नः ॥ १ ॥

> *dhānāvaṃtaṃ | karaṃbhiṇaṃ | apūpavaṃtaṃ | ukkinaṃ |*
> *iṃdra | prātaḥ | juṣasva | naḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र धानावंतं । धाना भृष्टयवाः । तद्वंतं करंभिणं । करंभो दधिमिश्राः सक्तवः । तद्वंतमपूपवंतं सवनीयपुराडाशोपेतमुक्थिनं शस्त्रिणं नोऽस्मदीयमिमं सोमं प्रातः प्रातःसवने जुषस्व । सेवस्व ॥ प्रातः । स्वरादिष्टंतोदात्तत्वेन पठितश्वादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *he iṃdra dhānāvaṃtaṃ | dhānā bhṛṣṭayavāḥ | tadvaṃtaṃ karaṃbhiṇaṃ | karaṃbho dadhimiśrāḥ saktavaḥ | tadvaṃtamapūpavaṃtaṃ savanīyapurāḍāśopetamukthinaṃ śastriṇaṃ no 'smadīyamimaṃ somaṃ prātaḥ prātaḥsavane juṣasva | sevasva ‖ prātaḥ | svarādiṣṭaṃtodāttatvena paṭhitaśvādaṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, the verse addresses you as धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*). धाना (*dhānā*) are parched barley grains, and the word means "having these". करंभिणं (*karaṃbhiṇaṃ*) means having करंभ (*karaṃbha*), which is barley meal mixed with curds. अपूपवंतं (*apūpavaṃtaṃ*) means accompanied by the purodāśa cakes of the pressing. ukthin means accompanied by the recited śastra. Sāyaṇa takes all four words as qualifying "this Soma of ours" (नः (*naḥ*)). The prayer is: accept (जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)), that is, enjoy, this Soma in the morning pressing (प्रातः (*prātaḥ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*)—that which is mixed with barley grain
- करंभिणं (*karaṃbhiṇaṃ*)—that which is mixed with curds
- अपूपवंतं (*apūpavaṃtaṃ*)—that which is accompanied by purodāśa and the like
- उक्किनं (*ukkinaṃ*)—that which is sanctified by the śastra-mantra
- नः (*naḥ*)—this Soma of ours
- प्रातः (*prātaḥ*)—at the time of the morning pressing
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept

Gist

O Indra, accept, at the time of the morning pressing, this Soma of ours, which is mixed with barley grain, mixed with curds, accompanied by purodāśa and the like, and sanctified by the śastra-mantra.

English translation

Accept, Indra, at our morning sacrifice, this libation, combined with fresh barley, with parched grain and curds, and with cakes, and sanctified by holy prayer.

Special Topics

धानापंतं (*dhānāpaṃtaṃ*): the Soma juice prepared by mixing in barley flour from which husk and chaff have been removed and which has been made clean. The Soma juice is not merely filtered and drunk as it is. To make it tasty, the āśira substances (milk, curds and barley flour) are mixed into it. Soma juice mixed with milk is called gavāśira, Soma juice mixed with curds is called dadhyāśira, and Soma juice mixed with barley flour is called yavāśira. We have explained this matter at length earlier. Here the word धानावंतं (*dhānāvaṃtaṃ*) denotes the Soma juice mixed with the flour called yavāśira.

करंभिणं (*karaṃbhiṇaṃ*): करंभो दधिमिश्राः सक्तवः । तद्वंतं । (*karaṃbho dadhimiśrāḥ saktavaḥ* | *tadvaṃtaṃ* |) It is Soma juice mixed with curds and flour. It is also called dadhyāśira.

अपूपवंतं (*apūpavaṃtaṃ*): पुरोडाशोपेतं । (*puroḍāśopetaṃ* |) Barley flour is kneaded, baked on an earthen griddle as one makes a flat bread, and then offered in the fire. This is called purodāśa. Here the word अपूपवंतं (*apūpavaṃtaṃ*) denotes the oblation called purodāśa.

उक्थिनं (*ukkinaṃ*): the meaning is "sanctified by recitation of the śastra-mantra and the like". It is the custom to purify the substances of the offering, before offering them, by reciting mantras and by sprinkling water and so on. Here the offering sanctified by mantras is described by the qualifying word उक्थिनं (*ukkinaṃ*).

इंद्र प्रातः जुषस्व नः (*iṃdra prātaḥ juṣasva naḥ*): O Indra, the yavāśira, dadhyāśira, purodāśa and so on that we offer are ready, sanctified by mantras. Indra is prayed to accept them at this time of the morning pressing.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पु॒रो॒ळाशं॑ प॒चत्यं॑ जु॒षस्वे॒न्द्रा गु॑रस्व च ।
तुभ्यं॑ ह॒व्यानि॑ सिस्रते ॥ २ ॥

> *puroḷāśaṃ pacatyaṃ juṣasvendrā gurasva ca |*
> *tubhyaṃ havyāni sisrate ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पुरोळाशं । पचत्यं । जुषस्व । इंद्र । आ । गुरस्व । च ।
> तुभ्यं । हव्यानि । सिस्रते ॥ २ ॥

> *puroḷāśaṃ | pacatyaṃ | juṣasva | iṃdra | ā | gurasva | ca |*
> *tubhyaṃ | havyāni | sisrate ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र पचत्यं पचने साधुं पुरोडाशं । पुरो दाशंत एनमिति
> पुरोडाशो हविः । जुषस्व । किंच आ गुरस्व । पुरोडाशभक्षणार्थमुद्यमं कुरु ।
> हव्यानि हवनयोग्यानि पुरोडाशादीनि हवींषि तुभ्यं त्वदर्थं सिस्रते । अहवनीयं
> गच्छंति । तानि सेवस्वेति भावः ॥ पचत्यं । पचतशब्दात्तत्र साधुरिति यत्पत्ययांतस्य
> पदस्य द्वच्त्वाभावादत्र यतोऽनाव इत्यस्य प्राप्तिर्नास्ति । तित्सरितः । गुरस्व ! गुरी
> उद्यमने । शविकरणी । निघातः । सिस्रते । सृ गतौ । छंदसि जुहोत्यादिः ।
> व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं ॥

> *he iṃdra pacatyaṃ pacane sādhuṃ puroḍāśaṃ | puro dāśaṃta enamiti*
> *puroḍāśo haviḥ | juṣasva | kiṃca ā gurasva |*
> *puroḍāśabhakṣaṇārthamudyamaṃ kuru |*
> *havyāni havanayogyāni puroḍāśādīni havīṃṣi tubhyaṃ tvadarthaṃ sistrate | ahavanīyaṃ*
> *gacchaṃti | tāni sevasveti bhāvaḥ ‖ pacatyaṃ | pacataśabdāttatra sādhuriti yatpatyayāṃtasya*
> *padasya dvactvābhāvādatra yato 'nāva ityasya prāptirnāsti | titsaritaḥ | gurasva ! gurī*
> *udyamane | śavikaraṇī | nighātaḥ | sistrate | sṛ gatau | chaṃdasi juhotyādiḥ | vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, accept the purodāśa that is पचत्यं (*pacatyaṃ*), good (fit) for cooking. Purodāśa is an oblation, explained as "they offer it first" (पुरो (*puro*) ...). Further, आ गुरस्व (*ā gurasva*): make an effort to eat the purodāśa. The oblations (हव्यानि (*havyāni*)), the purodāśa and other offerings fit for offering, flow (सिस्रते (*sistrate*)) for you, that is, go to the āhavanīya fire for your sake. The sense is: enjoy them.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- पचत्यं (*pacatyaṃ*)—that which is cooked
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—the oblation in the form of purodāśa

- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept
- आ गुरस्व (*ā gurasva*)—strive for it
- हव्यानि (*havyāni*)—all the oblations
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—intended for you alone
- stream and flow (accept them)

Gist

O Indra, accept the oblation in the form of cooked purodāśa. Strive for it. All the oblations flow to you alone. Accept them.

English translation

Accept, Indra, the prepared cakes and butter; eat them eagerly : the oblations flow for you.

Special Topics

पुरोळाशं पचत्यं (*puroḷāśaṃ pacatyaṃ*): पचने साधुं पुरोडाशं । पुरो दाशंत एनमिति पुरोडाशो हविः । (*pacane sādhuṃ puroḍāśaṃ | puro dāśaṃta enamiti puroḍāśo haviḥ* |) The etymological meaning of the word purodāśa is explained as follows: when oblations are offered to the gods, the oblation that is given before everything else is called purodāśa. The idea is that this purodāśa is well cooked and fit to be eaten.

तुभ्यं हव्यानि सिस्रते (*tubhyaṃ havyāni sisrate*): हवनयोग्यानि पुरोडाशादीनि हवींष त्वदर्थं आहवनीयं गच्छंति । (*havanayogyāni puroḍāśādīni havīṃṣa tvadarthaṃ āhavanīyaṃ gacchaṃti* |) Oblations such as purodāśa, which are fit to be offered, have been prepared and placed for you, Indra, near the āhavanīya fire. Indra is prayed to accept them.

Why must the purodāśa and other oblations be placed near the āhavanīya fire? Could they not be offered to Indra directly? The answer given: Indra is not a deity present before the eyes. Moreover, the established method of offering oblations to the gods is solely by offering them with mantras in the consecrated fire. Therefore the oblations are prepared and placed near the āhavanīya fire so as to be offered in that fire in that manner.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पु॒रो॒ळाशं॑ च नो॒ घसो॑ जो॒षया॑से॒ गिर॑श्च नः ।
व॒धू॒युरि॑व॒ योष॑णाम् ॥ ३ ॥

> *puroḷāśaṃ ca no ghaso joṣayāse giraśca naḥ |*
> *vadhūyuriva yoṣaṇām ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पुरोळाशं । च । नः । घसः । जोषयासे । गिरः । च । नः ।
> वधूयुःकशव । योषणां ॥ ३ ॥

> *puroḷāśaṃ | ca | naḥ | ghasaḥ | joṣayāse | giraḥ | ca | naḥ |*
> *vadhūyuḥkaśava | yoṣaṇāṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इ द्र नोऽस्मत्संबंधिनं पुरोडाशं घसः । भक्षय च । नोऽस्मदीयाः
> स्तुतिलक्षणा गिरो जोषयासे । सेवस्व च । तत्र दृष्टांतः । वधूयुरिव योषणां।
> यथा वधूयुः स्त्रीकामो योषणां भजनीयां युवतिं सेवते तद्वत् ॥ घसः ।
> घस्ल, अदन इत्यस्य लेट्यडागमे रूपं । चवायोगे प्रथमेति न निघातः । चोष–

> *he i dra no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhinaṃ puroḍāśaṃ ghasaḥ | bhakṣaya ca | no 'smadīyāḥ*
> *stutilakṣaṇā giro joṣayāse | sevasva ca | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | vadhūyuriva yoṣaṇāṃ|*
> *yathā vadhūyuḥ strīkāmo yoṣaṇāṃ bhajanīyāṃ yuvatiṃ sevate tadvat ‖ ghasaḥ |*
> *ghasla, adana ityasya leṭyaḍāgame rūpaṃ | cavāyoge prathameti na nighātaḥ | coṣa-*

> यासे । जुषी प्रीतिसेवनयोरित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लेट्याडागमे रूपं । आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वे णिच्
> स्वरः । पादादित्वादनिघातः । वधूयुरिव । सुप आत्मनः क्यच् । क्याच्छंदसीत्युप्रत्ययः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । योषणां । युष भजन इति सौत्रो धातुः । कृत्यल्युटो बहुलमिति ल्युट् ।
> लित्स्वरः ॥

> *yāse | juṣī prītisevanayorityasya ṇyaṃtasya leṭyāḍāgame rūpaṃ | āgamasyānudāttatve ṇic svaraḥ | pādāditvādanighātaḥ | vadhūyuriva | supa ātmanaḥ kyac | kyācchaṃdasītyupratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | yoṣaṇāṃ | yuṣa bhajana iti sautro dhātuḥ | kṛtyalyuṭo bahulamiti lyuṭ | litsvaraḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, eat (घसः (*ghasaḥ*)) our purodāśa, and accept (जोषयासे (*joṣayāse*)) our words of praise. The example is वधूयुरिव योषणां (*vadhūyuriva yoṣaṇāṃ*): as one desirous of a woman (वधूयुः (*vadhūyuḥ*)) enjoys a young woman (योषणां (*yoṣaṇāṃ*)) worthy of being enjoyed, so you accept. The rest of the block, which begins at घसः (*ghasaḥ*) and breaks off at the page end, is grammatical.

This block continues the grammatical derivations of the preceding block (the forms जोषयासे (*joṣayāse*), वधूयुरिव (*vadhūyuriva*), योषणां (*yoṣaṇāṃ*)). It adds nothing to the sense.

Word-to-word meaning

- नः (*naḥ*)—our (O Indra)
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—the purodāśa
- घसः (*ghasaḥ*)—eat
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- गिरः च (*giraḥ ca*)—the speech in the form of praise
- योषणां (*yoṣaṇāṃ*)—a beautiful woman
- वधूयः इव (*vadhūyaḥ iva*)—as a man desirous of a woman enjoys
- जोषयासे (*joṣayāse*)—accept

Gist

O Indra, eat our purodāśa. As a man desirous of a woman enjoys a beautiful woman, accept our speech in the form of praise.

English translation

Eat, Indra, our (offered) cakes and butter : derive enjoyment from our praises, as a lover from his mistress.

Special Topics

In this verse, in praying to Indra, the prayer is that he should eat the oblation called purodāśa with relish and listen to our praises. The seer has given an example for this. A young man attached to a woman, that is, to a newly married young bride, is eager to join her. In the same way, let Indra listen to our praise with the greatest relish and eat the oblations that we offer. This is the comparison stated here.

Ṛk 4

Samhitā-pāṭha

पु॒रो॒ळाशं॑ सनश्रुत प्रातःसा॒वे जु॑षस्व नः ।
इ॒न्द्र॒ क्रतु॒र्हि ते॑ बृ॒हन् ॥ ४ ॥

> *puroḷāśaṃ sanaśruta prātaḥsāve juṣasva naḥ |*
> *indra kraturhi te bṛhan ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पुरोळाशं । सनश्रुत । प्रातःसावे । जुषस्व । नः ।

> *puroḷāśaṃ | sanaśruta | prātaḥsāve | juṣasva | naḥ |*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे सनश्रुत पुराणतया प्रसिद्ध हे इंद्र नोऽस्मत्संबंधिनमिमं पुरोडाशं
> प्रातःसावे । सूयतेऽत्र सोम इति सावः । तस्मिन् प्रातःसवने जषस्व । यतस्ते प
> तव क्रतुः कर्म बृहन् महद्धि ॥ प्रातःसावे । षुञ् अभिषवे । कर्मणि घञ् ।
> प्रादिसमासः । थाथादिस्वरेणांतोदात्तः ॥

> *he sanaśruta purāṇatayā prasiddha he iṃdra no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhinamimaṃ puroḍāśaṃ*
> *prātaḥsāve | sūyate 'tra soma iti sāvaḥ | tasmin prātaḥsavane jaṣasva | yataste pa*
> *tava kratuḥ karma bṛhan mahaddhi ‖ prātaḥsāve | ṣuñ abhiṣave | karmaṇi ghañ |*
> *prādisamāsaḥ | thāthādisvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Sanaśruta, O Indra, famed as ancient, accept this purodāśa of ours in the प्रातःसावे (*prātaḥsāve*), that is, in the morning pressing. सावः (*sāvaḥ*) is explained as "that in which Soma is pressed". The reason given is that your क्रतुः (*kratuḥ*), your work, is great (बृहन् महद्धि (*bṛhan mahaddhi*)). The remainder of the block is grammatical.

Word-to-word meaning

- सनश्रुत (*sanaśruta*)—famed as ancient
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—given by us
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—the purodāśa
- प्रातःसावे (*prātaḥsāve*)—in the morning pressing
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept
- ते (*te*)—your
- क्रतुः (*kratuḥ*)—work
- बृहन् हि (*bṛhan hi*)—is it not of great nature?

Gist

O Indra, famed as ancient, accept at the time of the morning pressing the purodāśa given by us. Your work is renowned as being of great nature.

English translation

Indra, renowned of old, accept our cakes and butter, offered at dawn; for great are your deeds.

Special Topics

प्रातःसावे (*prātaḥsāve*): सूयतेऽत्र सोम इति सावः । तस्मिन् प्रातस्सवने । (*sūyate 'tra soma iti sāvaḥ* | *tasmin prātassavane* |) Because in this rite the Soma juice is pressed out and prepared, it is called सावः (*sāvaḥ*) or pressing. This rite performed in the morning is called the morning pressing, that performed at midday the midday pressing, and that performed in the evening the third pressing. According to the Śruti sentence त्रीणि वाव सवनानि (*trīṇi vāva savanāni*), there are only these three pressings.

Here only the morning pressing is indicated. In Ṛks 1–4 of this sūkta the morning pressing is the subject, in Ṛk 5 the midday pressing, and in Ṛk 6 the third pressing.

इंद्र क्रतुः हि ते बृहत् (*iṃdra kratuḥ hi te bṛhat*): Since Indra has performed many deeds of valour, such as the slaying of Vṛtra, he is praised here thus: O Indra, your deed of valour is very great, that is, extraordinary.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

माध्यं॑दिनस्य॒ सव॑नस्य धा॒नाः पु॑रो॒ळाश॑मिन्द्र कृष्वे॒ह
चारु॑म् ।
प्र यत्स्तो॒ता ज॑रि॒ता तूर्ण्य॑र्थो वृषा॒यमा॑ण॒ उप॑ गी॒र्भि
रीट्टे॑ ॥ ५ ॥

> *mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānāḥ puroḷāśamindra kṛṣveha cārum |*
> *pra yatstotā jaritā tūrṇyartho vṛṣāyamāṇa upa gīrbhirīṭṭe ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> माध्यंदिनस्य । सवनस्य । धानाः । पुरोळाशं । इंद्र । कृष्ण । इह । चारुं ।
> प्र । यत् । स्तोता । जरिता । तूर्णीर्थः । वृषयमाणः । उप । गीःभिः ईट्टे॥

> *mādhyaṃdinasya | savanasya | dhānāḥ | puroḷāśaṃ | iṃdra | kṛṣṇa |*
> *iha | cāruṃ |*
> *pra | yat | stotā | jaritā | tūrṇīrthaḥ | vṛṣayamāṇaḥ | upa | gīḥbhiḥ*
> *īṭṭe‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> माध्यंदिनसवने सवनीयपुरोडाशस्य माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धाना इत्यनुवाक्य । सूत्रितं च ।
> माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धाना इति माध्यंदिने । आ. ५–४ । इति ॥
> हे इंद्र माध्यंदिनस्य मध्यंदिने भवस्य सवनस्य संबंधिनीर्धाना बृष्टयवान् चारुं कमनीयं
> पुरोडाशं चेह कर्मण्यागत्य कृष्ण । भक्षणेन संस्कुरु ।

> यद्यदा जरिता भवत्परिचरणं कुर्वाणस्पूर्णर्थस्त्वां स्तोतुमितस्ततस्त्वरितगमनः
> अत एव वृषायमाणो वृषेवाचरन् स्तोता गीर्भिः स्तुतिलक्षणाभिर्वाग्निरुप समीपे
> प्रेट्टे प्रकर्षेण स्तौति । तदा पुरोडाशादिहवींषि भक्षयेति भावः ॥ माध्यंदिनस्य ।
> मध्यंदिनशब्दात्तत्र भवार्थ उत्सादित्वादञ् । ञ्त्वा दाम्युदात्तः । चारुं। चर गतिभक्षणयोः ।
> दृसनिजनिचरिचटिरहिभ्यो ञ्णिणि ञुण् । णित्वादुपधावृद्धिः । ञ्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । तूर्णार्थः ।
> तूर्तिः । ञ्त्वरा संभ्रम इत्याद्वहिश्रीत्यादिना निप्रत्ययो निच्च । अर्थः । ऋ गतौ ।
> उषिकुषिगार्तिभ्यस्थन्निति धन् । बहुव्रीह पूर्वपदस्वरः । वृषायमाणः । वृषेवाचरतीत्यर्थे कर्तुः
> क्यज् सलोपश्चति क्यज् । अकृत्सार्वधातुकयोर्दीर्घः । ञ्त्वादनुदात्तजित इत्यात्मनेपदं । लट्
> । शानच् ।
> तस्य लसार्वधातुकस्वरे धातुस्वरः । ईट्टे ! ईड स्तुतावित्यस्य लट रूपं । यद्योगादनिघातः
> ।'

> *mādhyaṃdinasavane savanīyapuroḍāśasya mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya*
> *dhānā ityanuvākya | sūtritaṃ ca | mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānā iti*
> *mādhyaṃdine | ā. 5-4 | iti ‖*
> *he iṃdra mādhyaṃdinasya madhyaṃdine bhavasya savanasya*
> *saṃbaṃdhinīrdhānā bṛṣṭayavān cāruṃ kamanīyaṃ puroḍāśaṃ ceha*
> *karmaṇyāgatya kṛṣṇa | bhakṣaṇena saṃskuru |*
> *yadyadā jaritā bhavatparicaraṇaṃ kurvāṇaspūrṇarthastvāṃ*
> *stotumitastatastvaritagamanaḥ*
> *ata eva vṛṣāyamāṇo vṛṣevācaran stotā gīrbhiḥ*
> *stutilakṣaṇābhirvāgnirupa samīpe*
> *preṭṭe prakarṣeṇa stauti | tadā puroḍāśādihavīṃṣi bhakṣayeti bhāvaḥ ‖*
> *mādhyaṃdinasya |*
> *madhyaṃdinaśabdāttatra bhavārtha utsāditvādañ | ñtvā dāmyudāttaḥ |*
> *cāruṃ| cara gatibhakṣaṇayoḥ | dṛsanijanicaricaṭirahibhyo ñṇiṇi ñuṇ |*
> *ṇitvādupadhāvṛddhiḥ | ñtvādādyudāttaḥ | tūrṇārthaḥ | tūrtiḥ | ñtvarā*
> *saṃbhrama ityādvahiśrītyādinā nipratyayo nicca | arthaḥ | ṛ gatau |*
> *uṣikuṣigārtibhyasthanniti dhan | bahuvrīha pūrvapadasvaraḥ |*
> *vṛṣāyamāṇaḥ | vṛṣevācaratītyarthe kartuḥ kyaj salopaścati kyaj |*
> *akṛtsārvadhātukayordiīrghaḥ | ñtvādanudāttajita ityātmanepadaṃ | laṭ*
> *| śānac |*
> *tasya lasārvadhātukasvare dhātusvaraḥ | īṭṭe ! īḍa stutāvityasya laṭa*
> *rūpaṃ | yadyogādanighātaḥ | '*

Summary

Viniyoga: the anuvākyā verse माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धानाः (*mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānāḥ*) is for the savanīya cake (puroḍāśa) at the midday pressing. It is prescribed in the sūtra माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धाना इति माध्यंदिने (*mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānā iti mādhyaṃdine*) (Ā. 5-4).

"O Indra, come to this rite and make fit by eating the roasted barley belonging to the midday pressing, that is, the pressing that takes place at midday, and the lovely, desirable cake. When the worshipper (jaritā), who serves you, hurries here and there to praise you, and therefore acts like a bull (vṛṣāyamāṇa), approaches you with hymns of praise and praises you intensely, then eat the cakes and other oblations." This is the sense.

The rest of the block is grammatical and is not summarised here (the derivations of māddhyandina, cāru, tūrṇārthaḥ, vṛṣāyamāṇaḥ and īṭṭe). He explains तूर्णर्थः (*tūrṇarthaḥ*) with तूर्तिः (*tūrtiḥ*) and इत्वरा संभ्रम (*itvarā saṃbhrama*), and says that ईट्टे (*īṭṭe*) is the present of the root ईड (*īḍa*), "to praise".

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- जरिता (*jaritā*)—the praiser
- तूर्णर्थ (*tūrṇartha*)—one who hurries about in eagerness to praise you
- वृषायमाणः (*vṛṣāyamāṇaḥ*)—one who is swift like a bull

(and intent on his duty)

- स्तोता (*stotā*)—the praiser
- गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)—with words in the form of praise
- उप (*upa*)—(you) approaching
- प्र ईट्टे (*pra īṭṭe*)—praises intensely (then)
- माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य (*mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya*)—offered at the time of the midday pressing

- धानाः (*dhānāḥ*)—the barley grains
- चारुं (*cāruṃ*)—satisfying
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—the cake
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrificial rite
- कृष्ण (*kṛṣṇa*)—(by your eating) make fit

Gist

O Indra, when the praiser, who hurries about like a bull in eager haste to praise you, approaches you with words in the form of praise and praises you intensely, then eat the barley grains offered at that midday pressing and the satisfying cake in this sacrificial rite, and make them fit.

English translation

Partake, Indra, of the barley and the delicious cakes and butter of the mid-day sacrifice, when by your zealous worshipper, hastening to adore you, and eager as a bull, is present, and celebrates (you) with hymns.

Special Topics

The Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra explains, in the sūtra माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धाना इति माध्यंदिने (*mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānā iti mādhyaṃdine*), that this Ṛk, माध्यंदिनस्य सवनस्य धाना (*mādhyaṃdinasya savanasya dhānā*), is to be recited as the puronuvākyā mantra in the cake-offering belonging to the midday pressing. (Ā. 5-4)

स्तोता जरिता (*stotā jaritā*)—Although these two words both indicate one meaning, "one who praises", the commentator explains a difference in meaning: for the word stotā he takes "one who praises with words in the form of praise", and for the word jaritā, भवत्परिचरणं कुर्वाणः (*bhavatparicaraṇaṃ kurvāṇaḥ*), "one who does service (śuśrūṣā) to you".

तूर्णर्थः (*tūrṇarthaḥ*)—त्वां स्तोतुमितस्ततस्वरितेगमनः (*tvāṃ stotumitastatasvaritègamanaḥ*). The word tūrṇi, formed from the word इत्वरा संभ्रमे (*itvarā saṃbhrame*), means "running about in eagerness". Here it means the ṛtvij, or the praiser, who runs about eagerly here and there in order to praise Indra.

वृषायमाणः (*vṛṣāyamāṇaḥ*)—This word is an adjective of the word stotā. It describes the praiser who hurries about like a bull: as a bull moves swiftly of its own will, so the ṛtvij runs about eagerly; this is the comparison with the bull. While a sacrifice is performed, the praisers and the ṛtvij priests help one another and run about eagerly, heedless of any toil, in order to work with devotion at their own duties. To indicate this, the seer has used the words tūrṇarthaḥ and vṛṣāyamāṇaḥ and has made his intention plain.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तृ॒तीये॑ धा॒नाः सव॑ने पुरुष्टुत पुरो॒ळाश॒माहु॑तं मामहस्व नः ।
ऋ॒भु॒मन्तं॒ वाज॑वन्तं त्वा कवे॒ प्रय॑स्वन्त॒ उप॑ शिक्षेम धी॒तिभि॑ः ॥ ६ ॥

> *tṛtīye dhānāḥ savane puruṣṭuta puroḷāśamāhutaṃ māmahasva naḥ |*
> *ṛbhumantaṃ vājavantaṃ tvā kave prayasvanta upa śikṣema dhītibhiḥ || 6 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> तृतीये । धानाः । सवने । पुरुस्तुत । पुरोळाशं । आहुतम् । ममहस्व । नः ।
> यभुमंतं । वाजवंतं । त्वा । कवे । प्रयस्वंतः । उप । शिक्षेम । धीतिभिः ॥ ६ ॥

> *tṛtīye | dhānāḥ | savane | purustuta | puroḷāśaṃ | āhutam |*
> *mamahasva | naḥ |*
> *yabhumaṃtaṃ | vājavaṃtaṃ | tvā | kave | prayasvaṃtaḥ | upa |*
> *śikṣema | dhītibhiḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> तृतीयसवने सवनीयपुरोडाशस्य तृतीये धाना इत्यनुवाक्य । सूत्रितं
> च । तृतीये धानाः सवने पुरुष्टुतेति तृतीयसवने । आ. ५–४ । इति ॥
> हे पुरुष्टुत पुरुभिर्बहुभिः स्तोतृभिः स्तुत हे इंद्र तृतीये सवने नोऽस्मदीयान्थाना हुतान्
> भृष्टयवानाहुतं पुरोडाशं च मामहस्व । भक्षणेन
> महय । संभावय । हे कवे इंद्र प्रयस्वंतः संभृतहविष्का वयमृभुमंतं ।
> ऋभवो ये केचन देवास्तद्वंतं । वाजवंतं । वाजो नाम सुधन्वनः पुत्रस्तद्वंतं त्वां धीतिभिः
> स्तुतिभिरुप शिक्षेम । समीपे परिचरेम ॥ आहुतं: । जुहोतेः
> कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः स्वरः । मामहस्व । मह पूजायामित्यस्य यज्लुगंतस्य
> लोट व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । शपो लुगभावश्च्छांदसः । शिक्षेम । शिक्षतेराशीर्लिंजि लिज्याशिष्यङ्ञ
> त्यज् प्रत्ययः। निघातः । धीतिभिः । हिष्ठवत्सरतिशत्थांतानामित्यंतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *tṛtīyasavane savanīyapuroḍāśasya tṛtīye dhānā ityanuvākya | sūtritaṃ*
> *ca | tṛtīye dhānāḥ savane puruṣṭuteti tṛtīyasavane | ā. 5-4 | iti ‖*
> *he puruṣṭuta purubhirbahubhiḥ stotṛbhiḥ stuta he iṃdra tṛtīye savane no 'smadīyānthānā hutān bhṛṣṭayavānāhutaṃ puroḍāśaṃ ca māmahasva |*
> *bhakṣaṇena*
> *mahaya | saṃbhāvaya | he kave iṃdra prayasvaṃtaḥ saṃbhṛtahaviṣkā vayamṛbhumaṃtaṃ |*
> *ṛbhavo ye kecana devāstadvaṃtaṃ | vājavaṃtaṃ | vājo nāma sudhanvanaḥ putrastadvaṃtaṃ tvāṃ dhītibhiḥ stutibhirupa śikṣema |*
> *samīpe paricarema ‖ āhutaṃ: | juhoteḥ*
> *karmaṇi ktaḥ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ svaraḥ | māmahasva | maha pūjāyāmityasya yajlugaṃtasya loṭa vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | śapo lugabhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | śikṣema | śikṣaterāśīrliji lijyāśiṣyajña tyaj pratyayaḥ| nighātaḥ | dhītibhiḥ |*
> *hiṣṭhavatsaratiśatthāṃtānāmityaṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Viniyoga: the anuvākyā तृतीये धानाः (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ*) is for the savanīya cake at the third pressing. It is prescribed in the sūtra तृतीये धानाः सवने पुरुष्टुतेति तृतीयसवने (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ savane puruṣṭuteti tṛtīyasavane*) (Ā. 5-4).

"O Indra, praised (purustuta) by many praisers, at the third pressing honour (māmahasva) our roasted barley, that is, the parched grains, and the cake that has been offered; honour them by eating, show them regard. O sage (kavi) Indra, we, who have gathered the oblations (prayasvantaḥ), serve you, who are accompanied by the Ṛbhus (ṛbhumantam), that is, by whatever gods are Ṛbhus, and by Vāja (vājavantam), the son of Sudhanvan, with our hymns (dhītibhiḥ), that is, praises; we attend upon you near." The remainder of the block is grammar (āhutam, māmahasva, śikṣema, dhītibhiḥ).

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)—O Indra, who are praised by many
- तृतीये सवने (*tṛtīye savane*)—at the time of the third pressing
- नः (*naḥ*)—offered by us
- धानाः (*dhānāḥ*)—the barley grains
- आहुतं (*āhutaṃ*)—offered in the form of an oblation
- पुरोळाशं (*puroḷāśaṃ*)—the cake
- मामहस्व (*māmahasva*)—eat and be satisfied
- कवे (*kave*)—O Indra, of far-reaching wisdom
- प्रयस्वंतः (*prayasvaṃtaḥ*)—we who have prepared the oblation
- ऋभुमंतं (*ṛbhumaṃtaṃ*)—you who are joined with Ṛbhu
- वाजवंतं (*vājavaṃtaṃ*)—and joined with Vāja
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- धीतिभिः (*dhītibhiḥ*)—with praises
- उप शिक्षेम (*upa śikṣèma*)—we approach and serve

Gist

O Indra, praised by many, at the time of the third pressing eat the barley grains offered by us and the cake offered as an oblation, and be satisfied. O Indra, of far-reaching wisdom, we who have prepared the oblation approach you, who are joined with Ṛbhu and with Vāja, by means of praises, and serve you.

English translation

Indra, you are praised of many, accept readily from our friend of barley, and cakes, and butter, offered at the third (or evening) sacrifice : laden with sacrificial viands, we approach with praises to you, sage Indra, who are accompanied by the Ribhus and by Vaja.

Special Topics

The Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra explains, in the sūtra तृतीये धानाः सवने पुरुष्टुतेति तृतीयसवने (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ savane puruṣṭuteti tṛtīyasavane*), that the Ṛk तृतीये धानाः (*tṛtīye dhānāḥ*) is to be used as the puronuvākyā mantra in the cake-offering belonging to the third pressing. (Ā. 5-4)

प्रयस्वंतः (*prayasvaṃtaḥ*)—संभृतहविष्काः (*saṃbhṛtahaviṣkāḥ*). The word prayas is read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9). Prayasvantaḥ means: "we who stand with the oblation in the form of food, prepared for offering to you, Indra, held in our hands."

ऋभुमंतं वाजवंतं (*ṛbhumaṃtaṃ vājavaṃtaṃ*)—In this Ṛk Indra is described as one who is with Vibhu[?73] and with one called Vāja. An explanation is necessary as to who the Ṛbhu and Vāja are.

It is said in many places in the Ṛgveda that the Ṛbhus were men in former times and attained divinity by their excellent conduct and the performance of good rites. In former times

the seer Aṅgiras had a son named Nītimañjari. The seer Sudhanvā, born in his line, had three sons, Ṛbhu, Vibhu and Vāja. It is believed that through good works, such as performing good rites, helping the gods and making sacrificial vessels and other implements, they obtained the birth of gods, or became gods. It is the custom to call these three sons of Sudhanvā, Ṛbhu and the others, together "the

Ṛbhus"; all three sons are called by the name of the eldest. Since they were pupils of Tvaṣṭṛ[?74], they are also called the craftsmen of the gods. It is said here and there that they made for Indra and the other gods the implements they needed, that is, a chariot for Indra and the camasa vessel for Agni. There are descriptions here and there that they have wonderful power and are able to do any work. In Ṛ. Saṃ. sūkta 1-20 an account is given of some of the works they did. Since they have the same power and capacity as the gods, the seers regard them as belonging to the company of the gods and describe them and their deeds in many ways. A detailed account of the Ṛbhus is given in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 5, pp. 658-662; the derivation of the form of the word Ṛbhu, Part 5-156 and 8-687; the description of how the Ṛbhus received the hospitality of Āditya and became worthy of drinking soma in the sacrifice, Part 8-666; the matter of the Ṛbhus making the camasa and other sacrificial vessels, Part 8-671; the matter of the Ṛbhus protecting the calf that had no mother, Part 8-693; Indra's companionship with the Ṛbhus, Part 8-699; and an account of the Ṛbhus' artistic skill, Part 8-704. All of this is explained in detail on those pages.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पू॒ष॒ण्वते॑ ते चकृमा कर॒म्भं हरि॑वते॒ हर्य॑श्वाय धा॒नाः ।
अ॒पू॒पम॑द्धि॒ सग॑णो म॒रुद्भि॒ः सोमं॑ पिब वृत्र॒हा शू॑र वि॒द्वान् ॥ ७ ॥

> *pūṣaṇvate te cakṛmā karambhaṃ harivate haryaśvāya dhānāḥ |*
> *apūpamaddhi sagaṇo marudbhiḥ somaṃ piba vṛtrahā śūra vidvān ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पूषण्वते । ते । चक्रम । करंभं । हरिऽवते । हरिऽअश्वाय । धानाः ।
> अपूपं । अद्धि । सगणः । मरुत्भिः । सोमं । पिब । वृत्रहा । शूर । विद्वान् ॥७॥

> *pūṣaṇvate | te | cakrama | karaṃbhaṃ | hari 'vate | hari 'aśvāya | dhānāḥ |*
> *apūpaṃ | addhi | sagaṇaḥ | marutbhiḥ | somaṃ | piba | vṛtrahā | śūra | vidvān ‖7‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र पूषण्वते । पूषा नाम कश्चिद्देवोदंतकः । तद्वते ते तुभ्यं
> करंभं दधिमिश्रं सक्तुं चक्रम । भक्षणार्थं कुर्मः । तथा च श्रुतिः । पूषा प्रसिष्ट–

> *he iṃdra pūṣaṇvate | pūṣā nāma kaściddevodaṃtakaḥ | tadvate te tubhyaṃ*
> *karaṃbhaṃ dadhimiśraṃ saktuṃ cakrama | bhakṣaṇārthaṃ kurmaḥ | tathā ca śrutiḥ | pūṣā prasiṣṭa-*

> भागोऽदंतको हि । तै सं, २–६–८ । इति । हरिवते । हरिनामकावश्वा । तद्वते
> पर्यश्वाय हरितवर्णाश्वयुक्तायेंद्राय तुभ्यं धाना भक्षणार्थं कुर्मः । तथा
> च मंत्रवर्णः । ग्रसेतामश्वा वि मुचेह शोणा दिवेदिवे सदृशीरद्धि धानाः । ऋग्वे.
> ३–३५ ३ । इति । मरुद्भिः सगणस्त्वमपूपं पुरोडाशमद्धि । भक्षय । हे शूर असहाये
> हे इंद्र वृत्रहा वृत्रस्य हंता विद्वान् सर्वं जानानस्त्वं सोमं पिब ॥ पूषण्वते ।
> पूषशब्दस्य मतुप् । अनो नुडिति नुडागमः । रषाभ्यामिति णत्वं । चक्रम । करोतेश्छांदसे
> वर्तमाने लिटि क्रादित्वादिदभावः । निघातः । हरिवते । छंदसीर इति मतुपो
> वत्वं ॥

> *bhāgo 'daṃtako hi | tai saṃ, 2-6-8 | iti | harivate | harināmakāvaśvā | tadvate*
> *paryaścāya haritavarṇāśvayuktāyeṃdrāya tubhyaṃ dhānā bhakṣaṇārthaṃ kurmaḥ | tathā*
> *ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | grasetāmaśvā vi muceha śoṇā divedive sadṛśīraddi dhānāḥ | ṛgve.*
> *3-35 3 | iti | marudbhiḥ sagaṇastvamapūpaṃ puroḍāśamaddi | bhakṣaya | he śūra asahāyè*
> *he iṃdra vṛtrahā vṛtrasya haṃtā vidvān sarvaṃ jānānastvaṃ somaṃ piba ‖ pūṣaṇvate |*
> *pūṣaśabdasya matup | ano nuḍiti nuḍāgamaḥ | raṣābhyāmiti ṇatvaṃ |*

> *cakrama | karoteścāṃdase vartamāne liṭi krāditvādidabhāvaḥ | nighātaḥ | harivate | chaṃdasīra iti matupo vatvaṃ ||*

Summary

"O Indra, you are Pūṣaṇvat. Pūṣan is a certain toothless god; to you, who are with him, we have made karambha, barley meal mixed with curds, for eating." A śruti confirms this: Pūṣan's share is a pounded one, for he is toothless (Tai. Saṃ. 2-6-8).

"Harivat: having horses called Hari; to you, Indra, who are Haryaśva, joined with horses of tawny colour, we have made roasted barley for eating." The mantra text says so too: ग्रसेतामश्वा वि मुचेह शोणा दिवेदिवे सदृशीरद्धि धानाः । (*grasetāmaśvā vi muceha śoṇā divedive sadṛśīraddi dhānāḥ* |) (Ṛgve. 3-35 3[?75]). "You, accompanied by the Maruts, eat the apūpa, the cake. O hero, that is, unaided, O Indra, slayer of Vṛtra, knowing all, drink the soma." The rest of the block is grammar (pūṣaṇvate, cakrama, harivate).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- पूषण्वते (*pūṣaṇvate*)—you who are joined with Pūṣan
- हरिवते (*harivate*)—you who have horses named Hari
- हरश्वाय (*haraśvāya*)—you who have horses of tawny colour
- ते (*te*)—for you
- धानाः (*dhānāḥ*)—the barley grains
- करंभं (*karaṃbhaṃ*)—the cake mixed with curds
- चक्रम (*cakrama*)—we have prepared
- मरुद्भिः (*marudbhiḥ*)—with the Maruts
- सगणः (*sagaṇaḥ*)—you who are in company
- अपूपं (*apūpaṃ*)—the cake
- अद्धि (*addi*)—eat
- शूर (*śūra*)—you who are valiant
- वृत्रहा (*vṛtrahā*)—slayer of Vṛtra
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—omniscient
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the soma

- पिब (*piba*)—drink

Gist

O Indra, for you, who are joined with Pūṣan, who have horses named Hari, who have horses of tawny colour, we have prepared the barley grains and the cake mixed with curds. You, who are in company with the Maruts, eat the cake. You, who are valiant, the slayer of Vṛtra, omniscient, drink the soma.

English translation

We have prepared the parched grain and curds for you, associated with Pushan ; the fried barley for you, lord of the tawny horses, associated with your steeds : attended by the troop of Maruts, eat the cakes; hero, you are wise, the slayer of Vritra, drink the libation.

Special Topics

पूषण्वते (*pūṣaṇvate*)—पूषानाम कश्चिद्देवोऽदंतकः । तद्वते (*pūṣānāma kaściddevo 'daṃtakaḥ | tadvate*). Pūṣan is a certain toothless god; the commentator explains it here as "to Indra, who is with him". Pūṣan is an important deity in the Ṛgveda; there are eight sūktas in his praise in the Ṛgveda. Besides this, in Ṛ. Saṃ. sūkta 6-57 with Indra, and in Ṛ. Saṃ. sūkta 2-40

...in the hymn he is praised together with Soma. His chief functions are to show the way to those who have lost it, to recover lost things, and to bring strayed cattle safely home. There are descriptions such as: "Scatter the enemies; may our path lead us to the things we desire" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-53-4); "Make the road good, and may the road reach a place of good pasture" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-42-7); "May he remove the troubles that may arise on the way and make the path auspicious" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-54-9; 10-59-7); "He is the protector of every path" (6-49-8). Therefore everyone setting out on a journey should worship Pūṣan, the builder of roads, reciting Ṛ. Saṃ. Sūkta 6-53, and all who have lost their way should take refuge in Pūṣan alone; this is stated in the Āśvalāyana Gṛhya Sūtra (Ā. Gṛ. Sū. 3-6-8, 9) and in the Sāṃkhyāyana Śrauta Sūtra (Sāṃ. Śrau. Sū. 3-4-9).

For a detailed account of the deity Pūṣan see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 5, pp. 547-550.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्रति॑ धा॒ना भ॑रत॒ तूय॑मस्मै पुरो॒ळाशं॑ वी॒रत॑माय नृ॒णाम् ।
दि॒वेदि॑वे स॒दृशी॑रिन्द्र॒ तुभ्यं॒ वर्ध॑न्तु त्वा सोम॒पेया॑य धृष्णो ॥ ८ ॥

> *prati dhānā bharata tūyamasmai puroḷāśaṃ vīratamāya nṛṇām |*
> *divedive sadṛśīrindra tubhyaṃ vardhantu tvā somapeyāya dhṛṣṇo ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्रति । धानाः । भरत । तूयम् । अस्मै । पुरोळाशं । वीरतमाय । नृणां ।
> दिवेऽदिवे । सद्यशीः । इंद्र । तुभ्यं । वर्धंतु । त्वा । सोमपेयाय । धृष्णोइति ॥ ८ ॥

> *prati | dhānāḥ | bharata | tūyam | asmai | puroḷāśaṃ | vīratamāya | nṛṇāṃ |*
> *dive 'dive | sadyaśīḥ | iṃdra | tubhyaṃ | vardhaṃtu | tvā | somapeyāya | dhṛṣṇoiti ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यजमानोऽध्वय्यादीन्प्रति ब्रूते । हे अध्वय्यादयः अस्मा इंद्राय
> धानास्तूयं क्षिप्रं प्रति भरत । संपादयत । नृणां वीरतमायास्मा इंद्राय
> पुरोडाशं च संपादयत । अथ प्रत्यक्षकृतः । हे धृष्टो शत्रूणामभिभवनशील हे
> इंद्र सदृशीगेकविधाः स्तुतयस्तुभ्यं त्वदर्थं दिवे दिवे प्रतिदिवसमस्माभिः क्रियंते ।

> *yajamāno 'dhvayyādīnprati brūte | he adhvayyādayaḥ asmā iṃdrāya*
> *dhānāstūyaṃ kṣipraṃ prati bharata | saṃpādayata | nṛṇāṃ vīratamāyāsmā iṃdrāya*
> *puroḍāśaṃ ca saṃpādayata | atha pratyakṣakṛtaḥ | he dhṛṣṭo*

> *śatrūṇāmabhibhavanaśīla he*
> *iṃdra sadṛśīgekavidhāḥ stutayastubhyaṃ tvadarthaṃ dive dive*
> *pratidivasamasmābhiḥ kriyaṃte |*

> ताः स्तुतयः सोमपेयाय सोमपानार्थं त्वां वर्धंतु ! उत्साहेन प्रवृद्धं
> कुर्वंतु ॥ सदृशीः । समानान्ययोश्चेति कञ्त्ययः । टिड्ढाणइत्यादिना जीप्
> दृगृशवतुष्टिति समानस्य सभावः ॥

> *tāḥ stutayaḥ somapeyāya somapānārthaṃ tvāṃ vardhaṃtu ! utsāhena pravṛddhaṃ*
> *kurvaṃtu ‖ sadṛśīḥ | samānānyayośceti kañtyayaḥ | ṭiḍḍhāṇaityādinā jīp*
> *dṛgṛśavatuṣṭiti samānasya sabhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

The sacrificer addresses the Adhvaryu and the other priests: "Priests, quickly bring fried barley (धानाः (*dhānāḥ*)) for this Indra, and prepare the cake (पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)) for Indra, the most heroic of men." Then, in the direct address of the second half: "O bold one, who overcomes enemies, Indra, praises of one like kind are made to you, for your sake, day by day, by us."

"May those praises make you grow, for the drinking of Soma; may they make you increase with zeal." (The grammatical remainder on सदृशीः (*sadṛśīḥ*) is left to the Grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- अस्मै (*asmai*)—addressing Indra
- धानाः (*dhānāḥ*)—barley grains
- तूयं (*tūyaṃ*)—quickly
- प्रति भरत (*prati bharata*)—procure (O Adhvaryus)
- नृणां (*nṛṇāṃ*)—among all leaders
- वीरतमाय (*vīratamāya*)—for you, who are exceedingly mighty
- पुरोडाशं (*puroḍāśaṃ*)—procure the cake
- धृष्टो (*dhṛṣṭo*)—capable of defeating enemies
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सदृशीः (*sadṛśīḥ*)—praises of one kind
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—for your praise
- दिवेदिवे (*divedive*)—are made every day (those same praises)

- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- सोमपेयाय (*somapeyāya*)—for the drinking of Soma
- वर्धंतु (*vardhaṃtu*)—may they make (you) grow

Gist

O Adhvaryus, quickly procure barley for this Indra. Procure the cake for Indra, who is exceedingly heroic among leaders. O Indra, capable of defeating enemies, praises of equal beauty are made for you every day. May those praises make you grow for the drinking of Soma.

English translation

Offer to him quickly (priests) the fried barley : offer to the most heroic of leaders the cakes and butter : may the like offerings, victorious Indra, presented to you daily, augment your vigour for the drinking of the Soma juice.

Special Topics

The bhāṣya explains that the first half of this Ṛk is a description in the indirect manner (parokṣakṛta) and the second half a description in the direct manner (pratyakṣakṛta). We explain here in detail what parokṣakṛta and pratyakṣakṛta mean. On this subject Yāska says in his Nirukta:

तद्यानि नामानि प्राधान्यस्तु तीनां देवतानां तद्दैवतमित्याचक्षते । यत्काम ऋषिर्यस्यां देवतायामार्थपत्यमिच्छन् स्तुतिं प्रयुंक्तेतद्दैवतः स मंत्रो भवति । शास्त्रिविधा ऋचः परोक्षकृताः प्रत्यक्षकृता आध्यात्मिकाश्च । तत्रपरोक्षकृताः सर्वाभिर्नामविभक्तिभिर्युज्यंते प्रथमपुरुषैश्चाख्यातस्य । अथ प्रत्यक्षकृता मध्यमपुरु षोपयोगास्त्वमिति चैतेन सर्वनाम्ना । अथाध्यात्मिक्य उत्तमपुरुषयोगा अहमिति चैतेन सर्वनाम्ना । परोक्षकृताः प्रत्यक्षकृताश्च मंत्रा भूयिष्ठा अल्पश आध्यात्मिकाः ॥ (*tadyāni nāmāni prādhānyastu tīnāṃ devatānāṃ tadvaivatamityācakṣate | yatkāma ṛṣiryasyāṃ devatāyāmārthapatyamicchan stutiṃ prayuṃkte tadvaivataḥ sa maṃtro bhavati | śāstrividhā ṛcaḥ parokṣakṛtāḥ pratyakṣakṛtā ādhyātmikāśca | tatraparokṣakṛtāḥ sarvābhirnāmavibhaktibhiryujyaṃte prathamapuruṣaiścākhyātasya | atha pratyakṣakṛtā madhyamapuru ṣopayogāstvamiti caitena sarvanāmnā | athādhyātmikya uttamapuruṣayogā ahamiti caitena sarvanāmnā | parokṣakṛtāḥ pratyakṣakṛtāśca maṃtrā bhūyiṣṭhā alpaśa ādhyātmikāḥ ||*) (Ni. 7-1 to 3)

That is, among mantras there are many kinds: mantras of the deity, praise-mantras, benedictions, oaths, curses, a statement of some matter, lament, censure and praise. A deity-mantra describes the greatness of deities; a praise is a mantra containing hymns and prayers; a benediction is a blessing, a wish for good; an oath is a vow; a curse is an evil wish; a statement of some matter is the explanation of a subject or principle; lament is grief and distress; censure is blame; praise is eulogy, praise of gifts and so on.

Among the many kinds mentioned, the Ṛks of the deity are of three kinds: parokṣakṛta, pratyakṣakṛta and ādhyātmika. Parokṣakṛta: because the deity praised is not present, mantras that use third-person nouns and verbs (third person both in subject and predicate) about that deity. Pratyakṣakṛta: Ṛks that imagine the deity praised as present and praise it by addressing it with second-person words such as "you", "your". Ādhyātmika: mantras that praise by using the first person. Of these three kinds, the parokṣakṛta and pratyakṣakṛta mantras are the most numerous; the ādhyātmika mantras are very few.

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Sūkta 53 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इंद्रापर्वतेति चतुर्विंशत्यृचं पंचदशं सूक्तं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका ।
> इंद्रापर्वता चतुर्विंशतिराद्यैंद्रापार्वती पंचदश्यादिद्वे वाचे ससर्पर्यै
> चतस्रो रथांगस्तुतयोऽंत्या अभिशापास्ता वसिष्ठद्वेषिण्यो न वसिष्ठा शृण्वंति ।
> दशमी षोडशौ जगत्त्रयोदशी गायत्रि द्वादशीविंशीद्वाविंश्योऽनुष्टु
> भोऽष्टादशी बृहतीति । विश्वामित्र ऋषिः । दशमी षोडशी च द्वे जगत्त्रयोदरी
> गायत्रि द्वादशीविंशीद्वाविंश्यस्तिस्रोऽनुष्टु भोऽष्टादशी बृहती शिष्टास्त्रिष्टु भः ।
> आद्येंद्रापर्वतदेवताका पंचदशीषोडशौ वाग्गेवत्ये तेदुत्तराश्चतस्रो रथांग
> देवताकाः शिष्टा ऐंद्रैः ॥

> *iṃdrāparvateti caturviṃśatyṛcaṃ paṃcadaśaṃ sūktaṃ |*
> *atreyamanukramaṇikā |*
> *iṃdrāparvatā caturviṃśatirādyaiṃdrāpārvatī paṃcadaśyādidde vāce sasarparyè*
> *catasro rathāṃgastutayo 'ṃtyā abhiśāpāstā vasiṣṭhadveṣiṇyo na vasiṣṭhā śṛṇvaṃti |*
> *daśamī ṣoḍaśau jagattrayodaśī gāyatri dvādaśīviṃśīdvāviṃśyo 'nuṣṭu*
> *bho 'ṣṭādaśī bṛhatīti | viśvāmitra ṛṣiḥ | daśamī ṣoḍaśī ca dve jagattrayodarī*
> *gāyatri dvādaśīviṃśīdvāviṃśyastisro 'nuṣṭu bho 'ṣṭādaśī bṛhatī śiṣṭāstriṣṭu bhaḥ |*
> *ādyeṃdrāparvatadevatākā paṃcadaśīṣoḍaśau vāggevatye tèduttarāścatasro rathāṃga*
> *devatākāḥ śiṣṭā aiṃdraiḥ ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn beginning इंद्रापर्वता (*iṃdrāparvatā*) has twenty-four Ṛks and is the fifteenth sūkta of the group. Sāyaṇa cites the Anukramaṇikā: the first Ṛk is Aindrāpārvatī; the fifteenth and sixteenth are addressed to Vāc, Sasarparī; four (17-20) praise the parts of a chariot; the last ones are curses against the enemies of Vasiṣṭha, which the Vasiṣṭhas do not hear. It gives the metres: the tenth and sixteenth Jagatī; the thirteenth Gāyatrī; the twelfth, twentieth and twenty-second

Anuṣṭubh; the eighteenth Bṛhatī; the rest Triṣṭubh. The seer is Viśvāmitra. The first has Indra and Parvata as deity, the fifteenth and sixteenth Vāc, the next four the chariot parts, the rest Indra.

> अनुवादवु– इंद्रापर्वता ऎंब ई सूक्तवु नाल्कनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हदिनैदनॆय
> सूक्तवु इदरल्लि इप्पत्तनाल्कु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—इंद्रापर्वता
> चतुर्विंशतिराद्यैंद्रापार्वती पंचदश्यादिद्वे वाचे ससर्पर्यै चतस्रो रथांगस्तुतयोन्या अभिशापास्ता
> वसिष्ठद्वेषिण्यो न वसिष्ठाः शृण्वंति । दशमीषोडश्य जगत्यौ
> त्रयोदशी गायत्रि द्वादशीविंशीद्वाविंश्योऽनष्टुभोऽप्वादशी बृहतीति ऎंदु हेळि
> रुवुदु. ऎंदरॆ— इंद्रापर्वता ऎंदु मॊदलागुव इप्पत्तु नाल्कु ऋक्कुगळुळ्ळ ई सूक्तक्कॆ
> विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु. मॊदलनॆय ऋक्कु इंद्रापर्वता ऎंब देवताकवु ; हदिनैदु मत्तु
> हदिनारने ऋक्कुगळिगॆ वाक्कॆ देवतॆयु ; ससर्परीः ऎंदु मॊदलागुव नाल्कु ऋक्कुगळिगॆ
> (१७–२० ऋक्कुगळिगॆ) रथांगगळॆ देवतॆयु ; २–१९ मत्तु २१–२४ ऋक्कुगळिगॆ इंद्रनु
> देवतॆयु;
> कॊनॆय नाल्कु ऋक्कुगळिगॆ (२१–२४) इंद्रनु देवतॆयागिद्दरू ई ऋक्कुगळु अभिशापार्थगळन्नु
> सूचिसुववु ; (अभिशाप ऎंब ऋक्कुगळ विषयवन्नु नावु 150ने पुटदल्लि विवरिसिदॆवॆ). ई
> अभिशाप
> वन्नु सूचिसुव कॊनॆय नाल्कु ऋक्कुगळु वसिष्ठरन्नू अवर वंशस्थरन्नू अनुयायिगळन्नू
> निंदिसुवुदरिंद अवुगळन्नु वसिष्ठगोत्रोत्पन्नरादवरु पठिसुवुदिल्ल, केळुवुदू इल्ल ई सूक्तद
> हत्तु मत्तु हदिनारनॆय ऋक्कुगळु जगतीछंदस्कवु ; हदिमूरनॆय ऋक्कु गायत्रिछंदस्कवु ;
> हन्नॆरडु, इप्पत्तु मत्तु इप्पत्तॆरडनॆय ऋक्कुगळु अनुष्टुप् छंदस्कवु ; हदिनॆंटनॆय ऋक्कु
> बृहतीछंदस्कवु ; उळिद ऋक्कुगळु (ऎंदरॆ; १–९, ११, १४, १५, १७, १९, २१, २३,
> २४ ने
> ऋक्कुगळु) त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्कवु.
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त–५३
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—४ ॥ सूक्त—५३ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—३ ॥ वर्ग—१९, २०, २१, २२, २३ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—२४ ॥
> । ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ॥
> देवता—१. इंद्रापर्वत् । २–१४, २१–२४ । इंद्रः ।
> १५–१६ वाक् । १७–२० रथांगानि ॥
> छंदः—१–९, ११, १४, १५, १७, १९, २१, २३, २४ त्रिष्टुप् ।
> १०, १६. जगती । १२, २०, । २२ अनुष्टुप् ।
> १३ गायत्री । १८ बृहती ॥
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> *anuvādavu- iṃdrāparvatā èṃba ī sūktavu nālkanèya anuvākadalli hadinaidanèya*
> *sūktavu idaralli ippattanālku ṛkkugaḷiruvavu anukramaṇikèyalli—*
> *iṃdrāparvatā caturviṃśatirādyaiṃdrāpārvatī paṃcadaśyādidve vāce*
> *sasarparyè catasro rathāṃgastutayonyā abhiśāpāstā vasiṣṭhadveṣiṇyo*
> *na vasiṣṭhāḥ śṛṇvaṃti | daśamīṣoḍaśya jagatyau*
> *trayodaśī gāyatri dvādaśīviṃśīdvāviṃśyo 'naṣṭubho 'pvādaśī bṛhatīti èṃdu heḷi*
> *ruvudu. èṃdarè— iṃdrāparvatā èṃdu mòdalāguva ippattu nālku ṛkkugaḷuḷḷa ī sūktakkè*
> *viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu. mòdalanèya ṛkku iṃdrāparvatā èṃba devatākavu ; hadinaidu mattu*
> *hadinārane ṛkkugaḷigè vākke devatèyu ; sasarparīḥ èṃdu mòdalāguva nālku ṛkkugaḷigè*
> *(17-20 ṛkkugaḷigè) rathāṃgagaḷe devatèyu ; 2-19 mattu 21-24 ṛkkugaḷigè iṃdranu devatèyu;*
> *kònèya nālku ṛkkugaḷigè (21-24) iṃdranu devatèyāgiddarū ī ṛkkugaḷu abhiśāpārthagaḷannu*
> *sūcisuvavu ; (abhiśāpa èṃba ṛkkugaḷa viṣayavannu nāvu 150ne puṭadalli vivarisidevè). ī abhiśāpa*
> *vannu sūcisuva kònèya nālku ṛkkugaḷu vasiṣṭharannū avara vaṃśastharannū anuyāyigaḷannū*
> *niṃdisuvudariṃda avugaḷannu vasiṣṭhagotrotpannarādavaru paṭhisuvudilla, keḷuvudū illa ī sūktada*
> *hattu mattu hadināranèya ṛkkugaḷu jagatīchaṃdaskavu ; hadimūranèya ṛkku gāyatrichaṃdaskavu ;*
> *hannèraḍu, ippattu mattu ippattèraḍanèya ṛkkugaḷu anuṣṭup chaṃdaskavu ; hadinèṃṭanèya ṛkku*
> *bṛhatīchaṃdaskavu ; uḷida ṛkkugaḷu (èṃdarè; 1-9, 11, 14, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 24 ne*
> *ṛkkugaḷu) triṣṭup chaṃdaskavu.*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta-53*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—4 ‖ sūkta—53 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—19, 20, 21, 22, 23 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—24 ‖*

> *| ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ ‖*
> *devatā—1. iṃdrāparvat | 2-14, 21-24 | iṃdraḥ |*
> *15-16 vāk | 17-20 rathāṃgāni ‖*
> *chaṃda:—1-9, 11, 14, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 24 triṣṭup |*
> *10, 16. jagatī | 12, 20, | 22 anuṣṭup |*
> *13 gāyatrī | 18 bṛhatī ‖*
> *172*

English translation (H. H. Wilson)

(Anuvāda in Kannada, not English.) The Kannada Anuvāda renders the above: Viśvāmitra is the seer of this hymn of twenty-four Ṛks. The first Ṛk has Indra-Parvata as deity; Ṛks 15 and 16 Vāc; Ṛks 17-20, beginning ससर्परीः (*sasarparīḥ*), the chariot parts; Ṛks 2-14 and 21-24 Indra. The last four (21-24), though addressed to Indra, express curses (the matter of abhiśāpa Ṛks was explained on p. 150). Because these four last Ṛks revile Vasiṣṭha, his descendants and followers, those born in the Vasiṣṭha gotra neither recite nor hear them. Ṛks 10 and 16 are Jagatī; 13 Gāyatrī; 12, 20 and 22 Anuṣṭubh; 18 Bṛhatī; the rest (1-9, 11, 14, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 24) Triṣṭubh.[?77]

Sūkta 53. Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 4; Sūkta 53; Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Vargas 19, 20, 21, 22, 23; number of Ṛks 24. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: 1 Indra-Parvata; 2-14, 21-24 Indra; 15-16 Vāc; 17-20 parts of the chariot. Metre: 1-9, 11, 14, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 24 Triṣṭubh; 10, 16 Jagatī; 12, 20, 22 Anuṣṭubh; 13 Gāyatrī; 18 Bṛhatī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्रा॑पर्वता बृह॒ता रथे॑न वा॒मीरिष॒ आ व॑हतं सु॒वी
रा॑◌ः ।
वी॒तं ह॒व्यान्य॑ध्व॒रेषु॑ देवा॒ वर्धे॑थां गी॒र्भिरिळ॑या॒ मद॑
न्ता ॥ १ ॥

> *indrāparvatā bṛhatā rathena vāmīriṣa ā vahataṃ suvīrāḥ |*
> *vītaṃ havyānyadhvareṣu devā vardhethāṃ gīrbhiriḷayā madantā ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रापर्वता । बृहता । रथेन । वामीः । इषः । आ । वहतं । सुवीराः ।
> वीतं । हव्यानि । अध्वरेषु । देवा । वर्धेथां । गीःभिः । इळया । मदंता ॥ १ ॥

> *iṃdrāparvatā | bṛhatā | rathena | vāmīḥ | iṣaḥ | ā | vahataṃ | suvīrāḥ |*
> *vītaṃ | havyāni | adhvareṣu | devā | vardhethāṃ | gīḥbhiḥ | iḷayā | madaṃtā ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंद्रापर्वता इंद्रश्च पर्वतश्च । हे इंद्रापर्वता बृहता रथेनागत्य वामिार्वननीयाः सुवीराः शोभनपुत्रोपेता इषोऽन्नान्या वहतं । अस्मदर्थ० धारयतं! प्रयच्छतमित्यर्थः। किंच हे देवौ द्योतमानावध्वरेष्वस्मत्संबंधिषु यज्ञेषु हव्यानि हवनयोग्यानि पुरोडाशादीनि हवींषि वीतं। भक्षयतं। तथेळयास्माभिर्दत्तेन हविषा मदंता हृष्यंतौ युवां गीर्भिः स्तुतिलक्षणाभिरस्मदीयाभिर्वाग्भिर्वर्धेथां । समृद्धौ भवतं ॥ इंद्रापर्वता । आमंत्रितस्य पादादित्वात्पाष्ठिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं । सुवीराः । बहुव्रीहौ वीरवीयौ चेत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । वीतं । वी
> कांत्यादिष्ठित्यस्य लोट्यदादित्वाच्छपो लुक् । प्रत्ययस्वरः । वर्धेथां । वृधु वृद्धावित्यस्य लोट्याथामो लसार्वधातुकस्वरे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *iṃdrāparvatā iṃdraśca parvataśca | he iṃdrāparvatā bṛhatā rathenāgatya vāmiārvananīyāḥ suvīrāḥ śobhanaputropetā iṣo 'nnānyā vahataṃ | asmadarthao dhārayataṃ! prayacchatamityarthaḥ| kiṃca he devau dyotamānāvadhvareṣvasmatsaṃbaṃdhiṣu yajñeṣu havyāni havanayogyāni puroḍāśādīni havīṃṣi vītaṃ| bhakṣayataṃ| tatheḷayāsmābhirdattena haviṣā madaṃtā hṛṣyaṃtau yuvāṃ gīrbhiḥ stutilakṣaṇābhirasmadīyābhirvāgbhirvardhethāṃ | samṛddhau bhavataṃ ‖ iṃdrāparvatā | āmaṃtritasya pādāditvātpāṣṭhikamādyudāttatvaṃ | suvīrāḥ | bahuvrīhau vīravīyau cetyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | vītaṃ | vī*
> *kāṃtyādiṣṭhityasya loṭyadāditvācchapo luk | pratyayasvaraḥ | vardhethāṃ | vṛdhu vṛddhāvityasya loṭyāthāmo lasārvadhātukasvare dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

इंद्रापर्वता (*iṃdrāparvatā*) means Indra and Parvata. "O Indra and Parvata, coming in a great chariot, bring desirable food (इषः (*iṣaḥ*)) accompanied by excellent sons; hold it for us, that is, give it. Further, O shining deities, partake of the oblations such as cakes offered at our sacrifices. Gladdened by the offering given by us, may you grow, be prosperous, by our praises of the nature of hymns."

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रापर्वता (*iṃdrāparvatā*)—O Indra and Parvata
- बृहता (*bṛhatā*)—of great form
- रथेन (*rathena*)—in (your) chariot
- वामीः (*vāmīḥ*)—praiseworthy
- सुवीराः (*suvīrāḥ*)—accompanied by excellent sons
- इषः (*iṣaḥ*)—food
- आ वहतं (*ā vahataṃ*)—bring
- देवा (*devā*)—you shining ones
- अध्वरेषु (*adhvareṣu*)—in the sacrifices
- हव्यानि (*havyāni*)—cakes and such, fit for worship
- वीतं (*vītaṃ*)—partake
- इळया (*iḷayā*)—with the oblation
- मदंता (*madaṃtā*)—you who are gratified
- गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)—by our words in the form of praise
- वर्धेथां (*vardhethāṃ*)—obtain prosperity

Gist

O Indra and Parvata, bring in your great chariot food that is praiseworthy and accompanied by excellent sons. Shining ones, partake in the sacrifices of the cakes and other oblations fit for worship.

Gratified by the oblation, obtain prosperity through our words of praise.

English translation

Indra and Parvata, bring hither, in a spacious car, delightful viands (generative of) good progeny : partake, deities, of the oblations (offered) at (our) sacrifices, and, gratified by the (sacrificial) food, be elevated by our praises.

Special Topics

इंद्रापर्वता (*iṃdrāparvatā*)—by this word Indra and a cloud, or the deity presiding over clouds, that is Parjanya, are addressed. The word occurs in the Ṛgveda only in this Ṛk and in Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-122-3 and 1-132-6, nowhere else. In explaining the word, the bhāṣyakāra says:

इंद्रापर्वता । इंद्रः प्रसिद्धः । पर्वतः पर्ववान् वृष्ट्यादिपूरणवान् पर्जन्यः ॥ (*iṃdrāparvatā | iṃdraḥ prasiddhaḥ | parvataḥ parvavān vṛṣṭyādipūraṇavān parjanyaḥ ‖*)

That is, Indra is the well-known deity; Parvata is the deity Parjanya, presiding over rain, who fills the earth with rain and the like. Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara says that the word parvata also means year (पर्वतःसंवत्सरः (*parvataḥsaṃvatsaraḥ*)). Whatever meaning is given to parvata, it is clear that here the word is a synonym for a deity to be worshipped. The word is also used as a synonym of enemy: since parvata is listed among the names of clouds (Ni. 2-21), in many places it is said that Indra caused rain by splitting the parvata; therefore an inquiry into the use of this word is proper.

The word parvata is used most in hymns to Indra and the Maruts. Its common meaning is mountain, but it is customary as a synonym of cloud. The Nirukta says: पर्ववान् पर्वतः । पर्व पुनः पृणातेः प्रीणातीर्वा मेघोऽपि गिरिरेतस्मादेव ! (*parvavān parvataḥ | parva punaḥ pṛṇāteḥ prīṇātīrvā megho 'pi giriretasmādeva !*) (Ni. 1-20). Showing that the word parva derives either from the root pṛ "to fill" or from the root prī "to worship, to satisfy", it explains parvata as mountain or cloud. The etymology gives the sense of filling a barren region, or of satisfying beings (with rain and the like). One must notice which parvata is the obstructing one and which the beneficial one.

In general, Indra's fight with the Asuras and with the mountains may be called a fight between darkness and light.

In the Ṛk वि चिद्वृतस्य दोधतो वज्रेण शतपर्वणा । शिरो बिभेद वृष्टिना ॥ (*vi cidvṛtasya dodhato vajreṇa śataparvaṇā | śiro bibheda vṛṣṭinā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-6-6), the sense is that with the thunderbolt whose joints (parvas) are a hundred in number and are of the nature of rays, he destroyed the Asura who is of the nature of darkness and who is a coverer. From such examples it can be said that, just as words like Vṛtra show the embodied form of the darkness that covers the world, so the word *parvata* also denotes darkness in the form of a mountain. Moreover, if one simply gives the ordinary meaning "hill" or "cloud", it does not yield the full sense that suits the contexts. For four kinds of achievement are described: releasing the cows and the waters that had been hidden away by the slaying of the *parvata*, and causing Uṣas and Sūrya to become manifest. Therefore, if the word *parvata* is explained only as "cloud", it does not suit the contexts.

In the Ṛk आदर्दरुत्समसृजो वि खानि त्वमर्णवान्बद्बधाना अरम्णाः । महांतमिंद्र पर्वतं वि यद्वः सृजो वि धारा अव दानवं हन् । (*ādardarutsamasṛjo vi khāni tvamarṇavānbadbadhānā aramṇāḥ | mahāṃtamiṃdra parvataṃ vi yadvaḥ sṛjo vi dhārā ava dānavaṃ han |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-32-1), and in the Brāhmaṇa sentence शिशुं नदीनां हरिमद्रिबुध्नमिति गिरिर्वा अद्रिर्गिरिबुध्ना ॥ (*śiśuṃ nadīnāṃ harimadribudhnamiti girirvā adrirgiribudhnā ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 7-5-2-18), it is understood that the words *parvata* and *megha* have an exalted, supernatural meaning. This is described as a mass of darkness in the form of a mountain, situated in the heavenly world, which hides the waters and the cow. Having split this darkness, Indra and the Maruts cause the water and the light to spread.

In Ṛks such as अहन्नहिं पर्वते शिश्रियाणं त्वष्टास्मै वज्रं स्वर्यं ततक्ष । (*ahannahiṃ parvate śiśriyāṇaṃ tvaṣṭāsmai vajraṃ svaryaṃ tatakṣa |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-32-2) it is said that Indra, who destroys Asuras such as Ahi, Śañjara[?78] and Vṛtra, who hide in this mass of darkness in the form of a mountain and obstruct the flowing water, is worthy of praise. In the same way, in many places the word *parvata* is described as a synonym of the enemy or as the enemies' refuge. Therefore in Ṛks such as आरंस्त पर्वतश्चित्सरिष्यन् (*āraṃsta parvataścitsariṣyan*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-11-7) and शुष्माचिदस्य पर्वता भयंते (*śuṣmācidasya parvatā bhayaṃte*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-12-13), it is said that as soon as Indra, who is of the nature of light, appeared, the masses of darkness in the form of mountains trembled with fear, and that Indra hid them away in the nether world—

Contrary to these descriptions, in many places it is also said that the *parvata* is the thunderbolt, which is of the nature of light, and Parjanya, the presiding deity of rain, water and the like.

In Ṛks such as प्राक्तादपाक्तादधरादुदक्तादभि जहि रक्षसः पर्वतेन (*prāktādapāktādadharādudaktādabhi jahi rakṣasaḥ parvatena*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-104-19) and अस्मे रुद्रा मेहना पर्वतासो वृत्रहत्ये भरहूता सजोषाः । (*asme rudrā mehanā parvatāso vṛtrahatye bharahūtā sajoṣāḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-63-12), the mountains are instruments that help Indra in the work of destroying enemies.

In Ṛks such as प्र पूषणं विष्णुमग्निं पुरंधिं सवितारमोषधीः पर्वतांश्च । (*pra pūṣaṇaṃ viṣṇumagniṃ puraṃdhiṃ savitāramoṣadhīḥ parvatāṃśca* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-21-9) and शं नः पर्वता ध्रुवयो भवंतु शं नः सिंधवः शमु सन्त्वापः । (*śaṃ naḥ parvatā dhruvayo bhavaṃtu śaṃ naḥ siṃdhavaḥ śamu santvāpaḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-25-8), the *parvata* is invoked together with deities such as Mitra, Varuṇa and Pūṣan.

In the places युवं तमिंद्रापर्वता पुरोयधा यो नः पृतन्यादप तंतमुद्धतं वज्रेण तंतमुद्धतं । (*yuvaṃ tamiṃdrāparvatā puroyadhā yo naḥ pṛtanyādapa taṃtamuddhataṃ vajreṇa taṃtamuddhataṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-132-6) and इंद्रापर्वता बृहता रथेन वामीरिष आ वहतं सुवीराः । (*iṃdrāparvatā bṛhatā rathena vāmīriṣa ā vahataṃ suvīrāḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-53-1), and in the present Ṛk as well, Indra and the *parvata* are invoked and praised together. Sāyaṇa has said that here *parvata* means Parjanya. Here the *parvata* is a deity to be worshipped[?79]

वामीः सुवीराः इषः (*vāmīḥ suvīrāḥ iṣaḥ*)—the word *iṣa* is read among the names of food (Ni. 3-9). Here the words *vāmīḥ* and *suvīrāḥ* are qualifiers of the word *iṣaḥ*. The meaning is: bring food together with sons who are to be obtained and who are heroes; that is, "bring the heroic sons and the food that may come to us through your grace."

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तिष्ठा॒ सु कं॑ म॒घव॒न्मा परा॑ गा॒ः सोम॑स्य॒ नु
त्वा॒ सुषु॑तस्य यक्षि ।
पि॒तुर्न पु॒त्रः सि॒चमा र॑भे त॒ इन्द्र॒ स्वादि॑ष्ठया गि॒
रा श॑चीवः ॥ २ ॥

> *tiṣṭhā su kaṃ maghavanmā parā gāḥ somasya nu tvā suṣutasya yakṣi |*
> *piturna putraḥ sicamā rabhe ta indra svādiṣṭhayā girā śacīvaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तिष्ठ । सु । कं । मघवन् । मा । परा । गाः । सोमस्य । नु । त्वा । सुसुतस्य ।
> यक्षि ।
> पितुः । नः । पुत्रः । सिचं । आ । रभे । ते । इंद्र । स्वादिष्टया । गिरा । शचीवः ॥ २ ॥

> *tiṣṭha | su | kaṃ | maghavan | mā | parā | gāḥ | somasya | nu | tvā |*
> *susutasya |*
> *yakṣi |*
> *pituḥ | naḥ | putraḥ | sicaṃ | ā | rabhe | te | iṃdra | svādiṣṭayā | girā*
> *| śacīvaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अहर्गणेष्वंत्यवर्जितेष्वहःसु हारियोजनस्य तिष्ठा सु कमित्यनुवाक्य ।
> सूत्रितं च। तिष्ठा सु कं मघवन्मा परा गा आयं यज्ञो देवया अयं मियेधः
> । आ. ६–११ । इति ॥
> हे मघवन्मनवन्निंद्र कं सुखेनास्मिन्यज्ञे सु तिष्ठ । सुष्टु कंचित्कालमत
> तिष्ठ । मा परा गाः । अस्मदीयाद्यज्ञाना गच्छ ॥ तत्र कारणमाह । सुषुतस्य सुष्ठभिषुतेन
> सोमस्य सोमेन नु क्षिप्रं त्वां यक्षि । यजे । हे शचीवः शक्तिमन्निंद्र
> ते तव सिचं वस्त्रप्रांतं स्वादिष्टया स्वादुतरया स्तुतिलक्षणया गिरा आ रभे । अलभे!
> गृह्णामीत्यर्थः । तत्र दृष्टांतः । पितुर्न । यथा पुत्रो मधुरया वाचा पितुर्जनकस्य चेलांचलं
> गृह्णाति तद्वत् ॥ सु कमिति निपातद्वयं । प्रथमस्य निपाता आद्युदात्ता इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> द्वितीयस्य चादयोऽनुदात्ता इत्यनुदात्तत्वं । सोमस्य
> यक्षि । यज देवपूजासंगतिकरणदानेषु । स्वरितञित इत्यात्मनेपदं । तस्य ल:जि

> सिचेकाच इतीट् प्रतिषेधः । व्रश्चादिना षत्वं । षढोः कः सीति कत्वं । सिचः सकारस्य षत्वं । निघातः । रभे । डुलभष् प्राप्तौ । लट्युत्तम इट रूपं । रलयोरभेदः । निघातः । स्वादिष्टया । स्वादुशब्दादिष्ठनि रूपं । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *ahargaṇeṣvaṃtyavarjiteṣvahaḥsu hāriyojanasya tiṣṭhā su kamityanuvākya |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca| tiṣṭhā su kaṃ maghavanmā parā gā āyaṃ yajño devayā ayaṃ miyedhaḥ*
> *| ā. 6-11 | iti ‖*
> *he maghavanmanavanniṃdra kaṃ sukhenāsminyajñe su tiṣṭha | suṣṭu kaṃcitkālamata*
> *tiṣṭha | mā parā gāḥ | asmadīyādyajñānā gaccha ‖ tatra kāraṇamāha | suṣutasya suṣṭhabhiṣutena somasya somena nu kṣipraṃ tvāṃ yakṣi | yaje | he śacīvaḥ śaktimanniṃdra*
> *te tava sicaṃ vastraprāṃtaṃ svādiṣṭayā svādutarayā stutilakṣaṇayā girā ā rabhe | alabhe!*
> *gṛhṇāmītyarthaḥ | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | piturna | yathā putro madhurayā vācā piturjanakasya celāṃcalaṃ gṛhṇāti tadvat ‖ su kamiti nipātadvayaṃ | prathamasya nipātā ādyudāttā ityādyudāttatvaṃ | dvitīyasya cādayo 'nudāttā ityanudāttatvaṃ | somasya*
> *yakṣi | yaja devapūjāsaṃgatikaraṇadāneṣu | svaritañcita ityātmanepadaṃ | tasya la:ji*
> *sicekāca itīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | vraścādinā ṣatvaṃ | ṣaḍhoḥ kaḥ sīti katvaṃ | sicaḥ sakārasya*
> *ṣatvaṃ | nighātaḥ | rabhe | ḍulabhaṣ prāptau | laṭyuttama iṭa rūpaṃ | ralayorabhedaḥ |*
> *nighātaḥ | svādiṣṭayā | svāduśabdādiṣṭhani rūpaṃ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

The anuvākya "tiṣṭhā su kam" is employed in the Hāriyojana rite on the days of the aharganas other than the last. It is also given in the sūtra (Ā. 6-11), which quotes the verse together with the formula beginning "ayaṃ yajño devayā". "O Maghavan, Indra, the wealthy one, stay happily (*kam*) in this sacrifice; stay well here for some time; do not go away from our sacrifice." He gives the reason: "I worship you quickly with the well-pressed Soma." "O Śacīvan, mighty Indra, I take hold of the hem (*sica*) of your garment, the edge of your cloth, with a sweeter (*svādiṣṭha*) speech in the form of praise." The example is "as a father's...": as a son with sweet speech takes hold of the hem of the cloth of his father, the begetter, so (I take hold of yours). The rest is grammar: *su* and *kam* are two particles, the first accented on the first syllable and the second unaccented; the derivations of *yakṣi*, *rabhe* and *svādiṣṭayā* follow.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—Indra, the wealthy one
- कं (*kaṃ*)—happily
- सु तिष्ठ (*su tiṣṭha*)—stay in this very sacrificial place
- मा पर्यागाः (*mā paryāgāḥ*)—do not go elsewhere from this place (because)
- सुषुतस्य (*suṣutasya*)—well pressed
- सोमस्य (*somasya*)—with Soma
- नु (*nu*)—quickly
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- यक्षि (*yakṣi*)—I worship
- शचीवः (*śacīvaḥ*)—mighty
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—Indra
- पुत्रः (*putraḥ*)—a son
- पितुः न (*pituḥ na*)—as (a son), taking hold of the hem of his father's garment, speaks to him (with sweet speech)
- ते (*te*)—your
- सिचं (*sicaṃ*)—the hem of the garment
- स्वादिष्टया (*svādiṣṭayā*)—most heart-pleasing
- गिरा (*girā*)—with speech in the form of praise
- आ रभे (*ā rabhe*)—I keep hold

Gist

O wealthy Indra, stay happily in this very sacrificial place. I shall worship you quickly with well-pressed Soma; therefore do not leave this place and go elsewhere.

O mighty Indra, as a son holds the hem of his father's garment while speaking sweetly, so I too hold the hem of your garment with most heart-pleasing speech, and I praise you.

English translation

Tarry awhile contentedly, Maghavan, (at our rite): go not away ; for I offer to you (the libation) of the copiously-effused Soma : powerful Indra. I lay hold of the skirts (of your robe) with sweet flavoured commen- dations, as a son (clings to the garment) of a father.

Special Topics

On the day before the last day of the sacrifice called Ahargaṇa, in the rite called Hāriyojana, this Ṛk "tiṣṭhā su kam" is to be recited as the puro'nuvākyā mantra; this is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra तिष्ठा सु कं मघवन्ना परा गा अयं यज्ञो देवया वयं मियेधः (*tiṣṭhā su kaṃ maghavannā parā gā ayaṃ yajño devayā vayaṃ miyedhaḥ*) (Ā. Sū. 6-11).

शचिवः इंद्र पितुः न पुत्रः स्वादिष्टया गिरा ते ३ चं आ रभे (*śacivaḥ iṃdra pituḥ na putraḥ svādiṣṭayā girā te 3 caṃ ā rabhe*)[?80]—हे शक्तिमन्निंद्र तव वस्त्रप्रांतं यथा जनकस्य चेलांचलं पुत्रो मधुरया वाचा गृह्णाति तद्वत् स्वादुतरया स्तुतिलक्षणया गिरा तव वस्त्रप्रांतं आलभे । (*he śaktimanniṃdra tava vastraprāṃtaṃ yathā janakasya celāṃcalaṃ putro madhurayā vācā gṛhṇāti tadvat svādutarayā stutilakṣaṇayā girā tava vastraprāṃtaṃ ālabhe* |). Here the word *śacī* is read among the names of speech (Ni. 2-23), among the names of action (Ni. 3-1) and among the names of wisdom (Ni. 3-13). Here the commentator explains it as "strength" and interprets it as "Indra who has power". In the sentence quoted above, the seer describes with an illustration: "O Indra, as a son, when speaking with affection and respect to his father, keeps hold of the end of the garment his father wears, so I too, holding the end of your garment, will speak loving, sweet words."

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शंसा॑वाध्वर्यो॒ प्रति॑ मे गृणी॒हीन्द्रा॑य॒ वाह॑ः कृणवाव॒ जुष्ट॑म् ।
एदं ब॒र्हिर्यज॑मानस्य सी॒दाथा॑ च भूदु॒क्थमिन्द्रा॑य श॒स्तम् ॥ ३ ॥

> *śaṃsāvādhvaryo prati me gṛṇīhīndrāya vāhaḥ kṛṇavāva juṣṭam |*
> *edaṃ barhiryajamānasya sīdāthā ca bhūdukthamindrāya śastam ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शंसाव । अध्वयो इति । प्रति । मे । गृणीहि । इंद्राय । वाहः । कृणवाव । जुष्टं
> आ । इदं । बर्हिः । यजमानस्य । सीद । अथ । च । भूत् । उक्तं । इंद्राय । शस्तं ॥

> *śaṃsāva | adhvayo iti | prati | me | gṛṇīhi | iṃdrāya | vāhaḥ | kṛṇavāva | juṣṭaṃ*
> *ā | idaṃ | barhiḥ | yajamānasya | sīda | atha | ca | bhūt | uktaṃ | iṃdrāya | śastaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> शंसिष्यन् होताध्वर्युं ब्रूते । हे अध्वर्यो आवां शंसाव । होतस्त्वमेव शंससि । कथमहं शंसानि । आत आह । प्रति मे गृणीहीति । त्वं मे प्रतिगृणीहि ।
> ओथामोदैवेत्यादिको होतुरुत्साहजननः प्रतिगरः । आ. ७–११ । तं दत्स्व । तथेंद्राय जुष्टं प्रीतियुक्तं वाहः स्तोत्रं कृणवाव । त्वं यजमानस्येदं बर्हिरस्मिन्बर्हिष्या सीद । उपनिश । अथ चानंतरमिंद्रायेंद्रार्थमावाभ्यां क्रियमाणमुक्थं शस्त्रं शस्तं प्रशस्तं भूत् । भवतु ॥ शंसाव । शन्नु स्तुतावित्यस्य लोट्युत्तमद्विवचने रूपं । आडुत्तमस्येत्याडागमः। उत्तमस्य
> पिद्वद्भावादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः
> मे । अनुप्रतिगृणश्च । पा. १–४–४१ । इति संप्रदानसंज्ञा । जुष्टं । नित्यं मंत्र इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *śaṃsiṣyan hotādhvaryuṃ brūte | he adhvaryo āvāṃ śaṃsāva | hotastvameva śaṃsasi | kathamahaṃ śaṃsāni | āta āha | prati me gṛṇīhīti | tvaṃ me pratigṛṇīhi |*

> *othāmodaivetyādiko hoturutsāhajananaḥ pratigaraḥ | ā. 7-11 | taṃ datsva | tatheṃdrāya juṣṭaṃ prītiyuktaṃ vāhaḥ stotraṃ kṛṇavāva | tvaṃ yajamānasyedaṃ barhirasminbarhiṣyā sīda | upaniśa | atha cānaṃtaramiṃdrāyeṃdrārthamāvābhyāṃ kriyamāṇamukthaṃ śastraṃ śastaṃ praśastaṃ bhūt | bhavatu ‖ śaṃsāva | śannu stutāvityasya loṭyuttamadvivacane rūpaṃ | āḍuttamasyètyāḍāgamaḥ| uttamasya pidvadbhāvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ*
> *me | anupratigṛṇaśca | pā. 1-4-41 | iti saṃpradānasaṃjñā | juṣṭaṃ | nityaṃ maṃtra*
> *ityādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The hotā, about to recite, says to the adhvaryu: "O adhvaryu, let us two recite." The adhvaryu says: "Hotā, you alone recite; how shall I recite?" Thereupon the hotā says "prati me gṛṇīhi": "You respond to me." The pratigara that begins with "oṭhāmodaiva" and encourages the hotā is quoted from the sūtra (Ā. 7-11): "give it." Likewise, "let us two make a pleasing (*juṣṭa*), loving *vāhaḥ*, that is, a praise-hymn, for Indra. Sit on this sacred grass of the yajamāna; settle down here. And after that let the uktha, the śastra performed by us two for Indra, be *śasta*, that is, excellent." The remainder is grammar (the derivation of *śaṃsāva*, the designation *sampradāna* for *me* by Pā. 1-4-41, and the accent of *juṣṭam*).

Word-to-word meaning

- अध्वर्यो (*adhvaryo*)—O adhvaryu
- शंसाव (*śaṃsāva*)—let us two praise (Indra)
- प्रति मे गृणीहि (*prati me gṛṇīhi*)—you concur with me
- इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)—addressing Indra
- जुष्टं (*juṣṭaṃ*)—affectionate
- वाहः (*vāhaḥ*)—a hymn of praise
- कृणवाव (*kṛṇavāva*)—let us two compose
- यजमानस्य (*yajamānasya*)—of the yajamāna
- इदं बर्हिः (*idaṃ barhiḥ*)—on this seat of darbha grass
- आ सीद (*ā sīda*)—sit down
- अथ च (*atha ca*)—and after that

- इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)—made for Indra
- उक्तं (*uktaṃ*)—the recitation of the śastra mantras
- शस्त्रं भूत् (*śastraṃ bhūt*)—may it be excellent

Gist

O adhvaryu, let us two praise Indra. You concur with me. Let us compose an affectionate hymn of praise addressed to Indra. Sit on this darbha seat of the yajamāna. After that, may the recitation of the śastra mantras made for Indra be excellent.

English translation

Adhwaryu, let us two offer praise : do you concur with me : let us address pleasing praise to Indra : sit down, Indra, on the sacred grass (prepared by) the institutor of the rite : and may our commendations be most acceptable to Indra.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the hotā addresses the priest called adhvaryu, and the seer describes him as saying: "Let us two, sitting on the darbha seat in this sacrifice performed by the yajamāna, praise Indra with excellent śastra mantras."

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

जा॒येदस्तं॑ मघव॒न्सेदु॒ योनि॒स्तदित्त्वा॑ यु॒क्ता हरं॑यो वहन्तु ।
य॒दा क॒दा चं॑ सु॒नवा॑म॒ सोमं॑म॒ग्निष्ट्वा॑ दू॒तो धं॑न्वा॒त्यच्छं॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *jāyedastaṃ maghavansedu yonistadittvā yuktā harayo vahantu |*
> *yadā kadā ca sunavāma somamagniṣṭvā dūto dhanvātyaccha ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> जाया । इत् । अस्तं । मघवन् । सा । इत् । ऊं इति । योनिः । तत् । इत् । त्वा ।
> युक्ताः । हरयः । वहंतु ।
> यदा । कदा । च । सुनवाम । सोमं । अग्निः । त्वा । दूतः । धन्वाति । अच्छ ॥ ४ ॥

> *jāyā | it | astaṃ | maghavan | sā | it | ūṃ iti | yoniḥ | tat | it | tvā |*
> *yuktāḥ | harayaḥ | vahaṃtu |*
> *yadā | kadā | ca | sunavāma | somaṃ | agniḥ | tvā | dūtaḥ | dhanvāti | accha ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मघवन्दनवन्निंद्र अस्तं । अस्यंते क्षिप्यंते पदार्था अत्रेत्यस्तं गृहं ।
> जायेज्ञाय्तैव गृहं भवति । न गृहं गृहमित्याहुर्गृहिणी गृहमुच्यत इति
> स्मृतेः । तथा सेत् सा जायैव योनिः पुरुषस्य मिश्रणस्थानं । उ प्रसिद्ध्यर्थः ।
> तस्मात्तदित् तत्र गृह एव युक्ता रथे योजिता हरयोऽश्वास्त्वा त्वां वहंतु ।
> वयं तु यदा कदा च त्वदर्थं सोमं सुनवाम अभिषुतं करवाम तदास्माभिः
> प्रहितो दूतोऽग्निस्ता त्वामच्छाभिमुख्येन धन्वाति । गच्छेत् ॥ अस्तं। असु क्षेपणे ।
> असिहसिमृग्रिण्वामित्यादिना तन्नत्ययः। नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । सुनवाम । षुञ् अभिषव
> इत्यस्य लोटि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । त्वा । युष्मत्तत्ततक्षुःस्वंतःपादमिति
> संहितायां षत्वं । धन्वाति । धवि गत्यर्थः । लेट्याडागमे रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *he maghavandanavanniṃdra astaṃ | asyaṃte kṣipyaṃte padārthā atretyastaṃ gṛhaṃ |*
> *jāyejjāytaiva gṛhaṃ bhavati | na gṛhaṃ gṛhamityāhurgṛhiṇī gṛhamucyata iti*
> *smṛteḥ | tathā set sā jāyaiva yoniḥ puruṣasya miśraṇasthānaṃ | u prasiddhyarthaḥ |*
> *tasmāttadit tatra gṛha eva yuktā rathe yojitā harayo 'śvāstvā tvāṃ vahaṃtu |*
> *vayaṃ tu yadā kadā ca tvadarthaṃ somaṃ sunavāma abhiṣutaṃ karavāma tadāsmābhiḥ*
> *prahito dūto 'gnistā tvāmacchābhimukhyena dhanvāti | gacchet ‖ astaṃ| asu kṣepaṇe |*
> *asihasimṛgriṇvāmityādinā tannatyayaḥ| nitvādādyudāttaḥ | sunavāma | ṣuñ abhiṣava*
> *ityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | tvā |*

> *yuṣmattattatakṣuḥsvaṃtaḥpādamiti*
> *saṃhitāyāṃ ṣatvaṃ | dhanvāti | dhavi gatyarthaḥ | leṭyāḍāgame rūpaṃ*
> *| nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Maghavan, wealthy Indra: *astam* is the house, because things are thrown (*asyante*) and placed there. Only the wife (*jāyā*) is the house," as the smṛti says: न गृहं गृहमित्याहुर्गृहिणी गृहमुच्यत (*na gṛhaṃ gṛhamityāhurgṛhiṇī gṛhamucyata*). Likewise, "she, indeed, is the *yoni* of a man, his place of mixing (*miśraṇasthāna*)"; *u* has the sense of "well known". "Therefore, in that very house, let the bay horses (*harayaḥ*) yoked to the chariot carry you. And whenever we press Soma for you, then Agni, the messenger sent by us, goes (*dhanvāti*) toward you, facing you." The remainder is grammar (the derivations of *astam*, *sunavāma*, *tvā* and *dhanvāti*).

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- जायेत् (*jāyet*)—the wife herself
- अस्तं (*astaṃ*)—is the house (for a man)
- सेत् (*set*)—she herself
- योनिः (*yoniḥ*)—the place of origin (with him)
- तदित् (*tadit*)—that very (sacrifice)
- गृहक्के (*gṛhakkè*)—to the house
- युक्ताः (*yuktāḥ*)—yoked (to your) chariot
- हरयः (*harayaḥ*)—horses
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- वहंतु (*vahaṃtu*)—let them bring
- यदा कदा च (*yadā kadā ca*)—in whatever circumstances
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—Soma
- सुनवाम (*sunavāma*)—we prepare (for you), (at those times)
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—the divine messenger
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- त्वा (*tvā*)—to you
- अच्छ (*accha*)—facing
- धन्वति (*dhanvati*)—let him come

Gist

O wealthy Indra, for a man the wife is the house. She herself is the place of origin. To that very sacrificial house, which for you is as a wife, let the horses yoked to your chariot bring you. Whenever we prepare Soma for you, at all those times let Agni, the divine messenger, come facing you.

English translation

A man's wife, Maghavan, is his dwelling ; verily she is his place of birth : thither let your horses, harnessed (to your car), convey you : we pre- pare the soma juice at the fit season : may Agni come as our messenger before you.

Special Topics

अस्तं (*astaṃ*)—अस्यंते क्षिप्यंते पदार्था अत्रेत्यस्तं गृहं । पदार्थगळु याव स्थळगळल्लि इडल्पडुत्तवॆयो आ स्थळक्कॆ गृहवु ऎंदरॆ अस्तं ऎंब शब्दक्कॆ मनॆयॆंदु भाष्यकाररु अर्थविवरणॆ माडिद्दारॆ. जाया इत्—जायैव गृहं (*asyaṃte kṣipyaṃte padārthā atretyastaṃ gṛhaṃ | padārthagaḷu yāva sthaḷagaḷalli iḍalpaḍuttavèyo ā sthaḷakkè gṛhavu èṃdarè astaṃ èṃba śabdakkè manèyèṃdu bhāṣyakāraru arthavivaraṇè māḍiddārè. jāyā it—jāyaiva gṛhaṃ*) is not used here; I give the sense only: the commentator has explained the word *astam* as "house": the place where things are put is called a house (*gṛha*).

जाया इत् (*jāyā it*)—जायैव गृहं भवति (*jāyaiva gṛhaṃ bhavati*). *Jāyā* means the wife or the housewife. Explaining the word *gṛha* to mean that for a man his own wife, or the place where his wife is, is regarded as the house, he gives in support of it the smṛti sentence न गृहं गृहमित्याहुर्गृहिणी गृहमुच्यते (*na gṛhaṃ gṛhamityāhurgṛhiṇī gṛhamucyate*) as an example. *Gṛha* does not mean a house or building built for dwelling. For a householder his own wife, or the place where the wife is, is called the *gṛha*. The sense of this sentence is that a house without a wife is not called a house. Therefore it is indicated that the role of the wife in the householder's home is of the greatest importance.

सा इत् योनिः उ (*sā it yoniḥ u*)—सा जायेव पुरुषस्य योनिः मिश्रणस्थानं (*sā jāyeva puruṣasya yoniḥ miśraṇasthānaṃ*). That wife is for the man the place of origin of pleasure and pain; "this is well known" means that a man obtains happiness only from his wife, and that in many circumstances, while carrying out household duties and so on, sorrow also arises. It is for this reason that the commentator has explained the word *yoni* as *miśraṇasthāna*, "a place together with happiness and sorrow". The sense is that this matter is well known, that is, known to everyone.

तत् इत् त्वा युक्ताः हरयः वहंतु (*tat it tvā yuktāḥ harayaḥ vahaṃtu*)—therefore let the yoked bay horses carry you there. तस्मात्तत्र गृह एव रथे योजयिता हरयोऽश्वास्तां वहंतु । (*tasmāttatra gṛha eva rathe yojayitā harayo 'śvāstāṃ vahaṃtu* |). For that very reason, may your horses bring you in the chariot to such a house. "House" here should be understood as the sacrificial house of the sacrificer (yajamāna). Just as a man comes eagerly to the house where his housewife or wife is, so the sacrificer's sacrificial house, where the sacrifice or Soma juice dear to Indra like a wife stands ready, is welcome to him. The ṛṣi prays that Indra's horses bring Indra in the chariot to such a sacrificial house.

यदा कदा च सोमं सुनवाम अग्निः त्वा दूतः अच्छ धन्वति । (*yadā kadā ca somaṃ sunavāma agniḥ tvā dūtaḥ accha dhanvati* |)—O Indra, whenever we prepare Soma juice for you, you must come toward our sacrificial house; for that Agni, as messenger, comes toward you (to you). This is the main purport of this sentence.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

परा॑ याहि मघव॒न्ना च॑ या॒हीन्द्र॑ भ्रातरुभ॒यत्रा॑ ते॒ अर्थ॑म् ।
यत्रा॒ रथ॑स्य बृह॒तो नि॒धानं॑ वि॒मोच॑नं वा॒जिनो॒ रास॑भस्य ॥ ५ ॥

> *parā yāhi maghavannā ca yāhīndra bhrātarubhayatrā te artham |*
> *yatrā rathasya bṛhato nidhānaṃ vimocanaṃ vājino rāsabhasya ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परा । याहि । मघवन् । आ । च । याहि । इंद्र । भ्रातः । उभयत्र । ते । अर्थं ।
> यत्र । रथस्य । बृहतः । निधानं । विमोचनं । वाजिनः । रासभस्य ॥ ५ ॥

> *parā | yāhi | maghavan | ā | ca | yāhi | iṃdra | bhrātaḥ | ubhayatra | te | arthaṃ |*
> *yatra | rathasya | bṛhataḥ | nidhānaṃ | vimocanaṃ | vājinaḥ | rāsabhasya ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अहर्गणेऽंत्यवर्जितेष्वहःसु हारियोजनस्य वैकल्पिकी परा याहीत्यनुवाक्या । परा याहि मघवन्ना च याहीति वानुवाक्येति सूत्रितं । आ. ६-११ ॥
> हे मघवन्थनवन्निंद्र त्वं परा याहि । अस्माद्वेदयजनात्पराज्मुखो गृहं
> प्रति गच्छ । अथवा देवयजनं प्रत्यायाहि । हे भ्रातः पोषकोभयत्रापि ते
> तवार्थं अर्यते प्राप्यत इत्यर्थः प्रयोजनं । अस्ति तत्र जायात्र सोमः !
> प्रयोजनांतरमाह । यत्र गृहं प्रति गमने बृहतो महतो रथस्योपरि निधानमवस्थानं प्रयोजनं ।
> अत्र स्थितौ रासभस्य हेषारवं कुर्वतो वाजिनोऽश्वस्य

> *ahargaṇe 'ṃtyavarjiteṣvahaḥsu hāriyojanasya vaikalpikī parā yāhītyanuvākyā | parā yāhi maghavannā ca yāhīti vānuvākyeti sūtritaṃ | ā. 6-11 ‖*
> *he maghavanthanavanniṃdra tvaṃ parā yāhi | asmādvedayajanātparājmukho gṛhaṃ*
> *prati gaccha | athavā devayajanaṃ pratyāyāhi | he bhrātaḥ poṣakobhayatrāpi te*
> *tavārthaṃ aryate prāpyata ityarthaḥ prayojanaṃ | asti tatra jāyātra somaḥ !*
> *prayojanāṃtaramāha | yatra gṛhaṃ prati gamane bṛhato mahato rathasyopari nidhānamavasthānaṃ prayojanaṃ | atra sthitau rāsabhasya heṣāravaṃ kurvato vājino 'śvasya*

> रथाद्विमोचनं प्रयोजनं ॥ अर्थं । ऋ गतौ । उषिकुषिगार्तिभ्यस्थन्निति थन् ।
> नित्स्वरः । निधानं । दधातेर्भावे ल्युट् । लितीति प्रत्ययात्पूर्वस्योदात्तत्वं ।
> रासभस्य । रासृ शब्दे । रासिवल्लिभ्यां च । उ. ३-१२५ । इति कर्तर्यभच्प्रत्ययः ।
> ग्रामादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *rathādvimocanaṃ prayojanaṃ ‖ arthaṃ | ṛ gatau |*
> *uṣikuṣigārtibhyasthanniti than |*
> *nitsvaraḥ | nidhānaṃ | dadhāterbhāve lyuṭ | litīti*
> *pratyayātpūrvasyodāttatvaṃ |*
> *rāsabhasya | rāsṛ śabde | rāsivallibhyāṃ ca | u. 3-125 | iti*
> *kartaryabhacpratyayaḥ |*
> *grāmāditvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

On the ahargaṇa, on the days other than the last, the verse परा याहि (*parā yāhi*) is an optional anuvākyā of the Hāriyojana; it is prescribed by the sūtra "परा याहि मघवन्ना च याहीति वानुवाक्या (*parā yāhi maghavannā ca yāhīti vānuvākyā*)" (Ā. Sū. 6-11). "O wealthy Indra, go away: turn your back on this place of the Veda-sacrifice and go to your house; or else come to the divine sacrificial place. O brother, nourisher: in both cases there is a purpose (artha: what is reached, a use) for you. There (at home) is the wife; here is the Soma." He then states the other purpose: in going home, the purpose is the standing (nidhāna, remaining) upon the great chariot; and if he stays here, the purpose is the unyoking from the chariot of the neighing horse (vājin), which makes a braying/neighing sound (rāsabha)…

The release from the chariot is the purpose. (The rest of the block gives the grammar of अर्थं (*arthaṃ*), निधानं (*nidhānaṃ*) and रासभस्य (*rāsabhasya*); रासभस्य (*rāsabhasya*) is derived from the root रासृ शब्दे (*rāsṛ śabde*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy one
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- परा (*parā*)—away from the sacrificial house
- याहि (*yāhi*)—you may go (or)
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—come to this sacrificial house
- भ्रातः (*bhrātaḥ*)—O Indra, the nourisher
- ते (*te*)—your
- अर्थं (*arthaṃ*)—purpose
- उभयत्र (*ubhayatra*)—is served in both ways

- यत्र (*yatra*)—by your act of going
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—great
- रथस्य (*rathasya*)—upon the chariot
- निधानं (*nidhānaṃ*)—your placing (becomes the purpose) (if you go home)
- रासभस्य (*rāsabhasya*)—your neighing
- वाजिनः (*vājinaḥ*)—of the horse
- विमोचनं (*vimocanaṃ*)—release (from the chariot) (becomes the second purpose)

> रथाद्विमोचनं प्रयोजनं ॥ अर्थं । ऋ गतौ । उषिकुषिगार्तिभ्यस्थन्निति थन् ।
> नित्स्वरः । निधानं । दधातेर्भावे ल्युट् । लितीति प्रत्ययात्पूर्वस्योदात्तत्वं ।
> रासभस्य । रासृ शब्दे । रासिवल्लिभ्यां च । उ. ३–१२५ । इति कर्तर्यभच्प्रत्ययः ।
> ग्रामादित्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *rathādvimocanaṃ prayojanaṃ ‖ arthaṃ | ṛ gatau |*
> *uṣikuṣigārtibhyasthanniti than |*
> *nitsvaraḥ | nidhānaṃ | dadhāterbhāve lyuṭ | litīti*
> *pratyayātpūrvasyodāttatvaṃ |*
> *rāsabhasya | rāsṛ śabde | rāsivallibhyāṃ ca | u. 3-125 | iti*
> *kartaryabhacpratyayaḥ |*
> *grāmāditvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Gist

O wealthy Indra, whether you depart from this sacrificial house or come here, there is a twofold purpose in both courses of action. By departing from here, your being seated in your chariot is one purpose. Or, if you stay here, the release of your neighing horse is another purpose.

English translation

Depart, Maghavan ; come Indra : both ways, protector, there is a motive for you, whether it be standing in your vast chariot, or liberating your neighing steed.

Special Topics

On the day before the last day of the sacrifice called ahargaṇa, in the rite called Hāriyojana, this ṛk "Parā yāhi" may optionally be recited as the anuvākyā mantra; this is stated by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, "परा याहि मघवन्ना च याहीति वानुवाक्या (*parā yāhi maghavannā ca yāhīti vānuvākyā*)" (Ā. Sū. 6-11).

भ्रातः (*bhrātaḥ*)—For this word, derived from the root भृञ् भरणे (*bhṛñ bharaṇe*), the commentator gives the meaning "Indra the nourisher". Or the meaning "brother" belonging to the word भ्रातृ (*bhrātṛ*) may also be taken. It should be understood that out of great regard Indra is addressed as brother.

रासभस्य (*rāsabhasya*)—रासृ शब्दे (*rāsṛ śabde*). हेषारवं कुर्वतः वाजिनः (*heṣāravaṃ kurvataḥ vājinaḥ*). The commentator says that this word is derived from the root रासृ (*rāsṛ*), meaning "to make a sound", and therefore explains the word as "of the horse that makes a sound, or that neighs".

In this ṛk it is explained that Indra (after coming to the sacrificial ground and drinking Soma) may stay right here, that is, on the sacrificial ground, if he wishes; otherwise he may depart to his own abode. In both these courses there is a purpose. How? If Indra goes back toward his own house, he will sit in his great chariot; our seeing this is the purpose. Or, if Indra stays here, then the horse harnessed to the chariot is unyoked and let loose, not yoked to the chariot; it will neigh with joy. Thus the ṛṣi has explained the purpose that lies in Indra's coming and returning.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अपा॒ः सोम॒मस्त॑मिन्द्र॒ प्र या॑हि कल्या॒णीर्जा॒या सु॒रणं॑ गृ॒हे ते॑ ।
यत्रा॒ रथ॑स्य बृह॒तो नि॒धानं॑ वि॒मोच॑नं वा॒जिनो॒ दक्षि॑णावत् ॥ ६ ॥

> *apāḥ somamastamindra pra yāhi kalyāṇīrjāyā suraṇaṃ gṛhe te |*
> *yatrā rathasya bṛhato nidhānaṃ vimocanaṃ vājino dakṣiṇāvat ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अपाः । सोमं । अस्तं । इंद्र । प्र । याहि । कल्याणीः । जाया । सुरणं । गृहे ।
> ते ।
> यत्र । रथस्य । बृहतः । निधानं । विमोचनं । वाजिनः । दक्षिणावत् ॥ ६ ॥

> *apāḥ | somaṃ | astaṃ | iṃdra | pra | yāhi | kalyāṇīḥ | jāyā | suraṇaṃ | gṛhe |*
> *te |*
> *yatra | rathasya | bṛhataḥ | nidhānaṃ | vimocanaṃ | vājinaḥ | dakṣiṇāvat ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अंत्येष्वहःसु हारियोजनस्यापाः सोममित्यनुवाक्या । सूत्रितं च । हारियोजनोऽपाः सोममस्तमिंद्र प्र याहि । आ. ६–११ । इति ॥
> हे इंद्र सोममपाः । अत्रैव स्थित्वा सोमं पिब । पीत्वास्तं गृहं प्र
> याहि । प्रकर्षेण गच्छ । ते तव गृहे कल्याणीर्मंगलकारिणी जाया शची विद्यते ।
> सुरणं शोभनगीतादिध्वनिश्चास्ति । यद्वा ।सुरणं सुरमणीयं यथा भवति तथा गृहे

> *aṃtyeṣvahaḥsu hāriyojanasyāpāḥ somamityanuvākyā | sūtritaṃ ca | hāriyojano 'pāḥ somamastamiṃdra pra yāhi | ā. 6-11 | iti ‖*
> *he iṃdra somamapāḥ | atraiva sthitvā somaṃ piba | pītvāstaṃ gṛhaṃ pra*
> *yāhi | prakarṣeṇa gaccha | te tava gṛhe kalyāṇīrmaṃgalakāriṇī jāyā śacī*

> *vidyate |*
> *suraṇaṃ śobhanagītādidhvaniścāsti | yadvā |suraṇaṃ suramaṇīyaṃ*
> *yathā bhavati tathā gṛhe*

> जाया तिष्ठति । यत्रेत्यादि गतं । दक्षिणावत् । अत्र स्थितौ सत्यां रथे योजितानां
> वाजिनां विमोचनं खादनपानादिना दक्षिणावत् प्रयोजनवद्भवति । विमुक्तेभ्यो
> वाजिभ्यो खादनं पानं चोपहरंति ॥ आपाः । पा पाने । लुजि गातिस्थेति सिचो
> लुक् । अडागमस्वरः । कल्याणेः । कल्याणमस्यास्तीति मत्वर्थे छंदसीवनिपाविति
> ईप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । सुरणं । रण शब्दार्थः । आस्मादकृच्छार्थे खल् ।
> लित्स्वरः । प्रत्ययस्य पित्तादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । समासे कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः ॥

> *jāyā tiṣṭhati | yatretyādi gataṃ | dakṣiṇāvat | atra sthitau satyāṃ rathe yojitānāṃ*
> *vājināṃ vimocanaṃ khādanapānādinā dakṣiṇāvat prayojanavadbhavati | vimuktebhyo*
> *vājibhyo khādanaṃ pānaṃ copaharaṃti ‖ āpāḥ | pā pāne | luji gātistheti sico*
> *luk | aḍāgamasvaraḥ | kalyāṇeḥ | kalyāṇamasyāstīti matvarthe chaṃdasīvanipāviti*
> *īpratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | suraṇaṃ | raṇa śabdārthaḥ | āsmādakṛcchārthe khal |*
> *litsvaraḥ | pratyayasya pittādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | samāse kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

On the last days, अपाः सोमं (*apāḥ somaṃ*) is the anuvākyā of the Hāriyojana; it is prescribed by the sūtra "हारियोजनोऽपाः सोममस्तमिंद्र प्र याहि (*hāriyojano 'pāḥ somamastamiṃdra pra yāhi*)" (Ā. Sū. 6-11). "O Indra, drink the Soma: staying right here, drink Soma. Having drunk, go to your house (astam), go forth. In your house there is your auspicious wife Śacī, and there is also the sound of fine songs and the like. Or else: your wife stays in the house in such a way that it is delightful to the gods (surana)…

…The rest of the sentence is as above ("yatra" etc., already treated). दक्षिणावत् (*dakṣiṇāvat*): if you stay here, the unyoking of the horses yoked to the chariot becomes fruitful (dakṣiṇāvat, "with a reward") through their eating, drinking and so on; for to the released horses they bring food and drink. (The rest of the block is grammar of आपाः (*āpāḥ*), कल्याणेः (*kalyāṇeḥ*) and सुरणं (*suraṇaṃ*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- अपाः (*apāḥ*)—drink (afterwards) to your house (astam)
- प्र याहि (*pra yāhi*)—go
- ते (*te*)—your
- गृहे (*gṛhe*)—in the house
- कल्याणीः (*kalyāṇīḥ*)—auspicious
- जाया (*jāyā*)—your wife
- सुरणं (*suraṇaṃ*)—is delightful to you
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—great
- रथस्य (*rathasya*)—upon the chariot
- निधानं (*nidhānaṃ*)—your placing
- दक्षिणावत् (*dakṣiṇāvat*)—becomes beneficial (or, if you stay here)
- वाजिनः (*vājinaḥ*)—of the horse
- विमोचनं (*vimocanaṃ*)—there is release (from the chariot)

Gist

O Indra, first drink the Soma. Afterwards go to your house. In your house your auspicious wife is a delight to you. Your being placed upon the great chariot is beneficial. Or, if you stay here, the horse is released from your chariot.

English translation

When you have drunk the Soma, then, Indra, go home : an auspicious life (abides) pleasantly in your dwelling : in either (case) there is the standing in your car or liberating the steeds for provender.

Special Topics

On the last day of the sacrifice called ahargaṇa this ṛk "Āpāḥ somaṃ" is to be recited as the anuvākyā mantra; this is stated by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, "हारियोजनापाः सोममस्तमिंद्र (*hāriyojanāpāḥ somamastamiṃdra*)" (Ā. Sū. 6-11).

In this ṛk too the matter stated in the previous ṛk is set out in detail. And there is also a description that in Indra's house Indra's wife welcomes him with the sound of auspicious songs.

इंद्र सोममपाः अस्तं प्र याहि (*iṃdra somamapāḥ astaṃ pra yāhi*)—O Indra, drink Soma on our sacrificial ground; after drinking, set out toward your own house. As was said in the 4th ṛk, here too the word अस्तं (*astaṃ*) is explained as "house".

कल्याणी जाया ते गृहे सुरणं (*kalyāṇī jāyā te gṛhe suraṇaṃ*)—तव गृहे मंगलकारिणी तव जाया (शची) विद्यते । शोभनगीतादिध्वनिश्चास्ति । (*tava gṛhe maṃgalakāriṇī tava jāyā (śacī) vidyate | śobhanagītādidhvaniścāsti |*) In your house there is your wife (Śacī), shining delightfully, that is, an ornament to the house; and there is the sound of the sweet songs and the like that she sings to welcome you; that is, it is heard. This is the purport.

यत्र रथस्य........दक्षिणावत् (*yatra rathasya........dakṣiṇāvat*)—What was said in the latter half of the previous ṛk is said again here. If Indra departs, he sits in his great chariot and gives darśana to all; if he does not depart but stays here, he has the horses of his chariot unyoked and sees that food and drink are provided for them: these two kinds of purpose are there, the ṛṣi says once more.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मे भो॒जा अङ्गि॑रसो॒ विरू॑पा दि॒वस्पु॒त्रासो॒ असु॑रस्य वी॒राः ।
वि॒श्वामि॑त्राय॒ दद॑तो म॒घानि॑ सहस्रसा॒वे प्र ति॑रन्त॒ आयु॑ः ॥ ७ ॥

> *ime bhojā aṅgiraso virūpā divasputrāso asurasya vīrāḥ |*
> *viśvāmitrāya dadato maghāni sahasrasāve pra tiranta āyuḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमे । भोजाः । अंगिरसः । विरूपाः । दिवः । पुत्रासः । असुरस्य । वीराः ।
> विश्वामित्राय । ददतः । मघानि । सहस्रसावे । प्र । तिरंते । आयुः ॥ ७ ॥

> *ime | bhojāḥ | aṃgirasaḥ | virūpāḥ | divaḥ | putrāsaḥ | asurasya | vīrāḥ |*
> *viśvāmitrāya | dadataḥ | maghāni | sahasrasāve | pra | tiraṃte | āyuḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र इमे यागं कुर्वाणा भोजाः सौदासाः क्षत्रियाः तेषां याजका
> विरूपा नानारूपा मेधातिथिप्रभृतयोंगिरसश्च दिवोऽसुरस्य देवेभ्योऽपि बलवतो रुद्रस्य
> पुत्रासः पुत्रा वीरा बलवंतो मरुतः ते सर्वे विश्वामित्राय मह्यं
> सहस्रसावे । सहस्रं सूयतेऽत्रेति सहस्रसावोऽश्वमेधः । तस्मिन्नश्वमेधे मघानि
> महनीयानि धनानि वदतः प्रयच्छंतः संत आयुर्जीवनमन्नं ना प्र तिरंते ।
> प्रकर्षण वर्धयंति ॥ दिवस्पुत्रास इति संहितायां षष्ठ्याः पतिपुत्रेति विसर्जनीयस्य सत्वं ।
> दवतः । डुदाण् दान इत्यस्य शतरि रूपं । अभ्यस्तानामादिरित्याद्युदात्तत्वं । तिरंते ।
> तरतेर्व्यत्ययेन शः ॥

> *he iṃdra ime yāgaṃ kurvāṇā bhojāḥ saudāsāḥ kṣatriyāḥ teṣāṃ yājakā*
> *virūpā nānārūpā medhātithiprabhṛtayoṃgirasaśca divo 'surasya*
> *devebhyo 'pi balavato rudrasya putrāsaḥ putrā vīrā balavaṃto marutaḥ*
> *te sarve viśvāmitrāya mahyaṃ*

sahasrasāve | sahasraṃ sūyate 'treti sahasrasāvo 'śvamedhaḥ |
tasminnaśvamedhe maghāni
mahanīyāni dhanāni vadataḥ prayacchaṃtaḥ saṃta āyurjīvanamannaṃ nā pra tiraṃte |
prakarṣaṇa vardhayaṃti ‖ divasputrāsa iti saṃhitāyāṃ ṣaṣṭhyāḥ
patiputreti visarjanīyasya satvaṃ | davataḥ | ḍudāṇ dāna ityasya śatari
rūpaṃ | abhyastānāmādirityādyudāttatvaṃ | tiraṃte |
taratervyatyayena śaḥ ‖

नानावर्णवुळ्ळ पृथ्वियु हिंदॆ गोरूपवन्नु धरिसिद्दाग महेशनु ऎत्तिन रूपदिंद मरुत्तु
गळन्नु उत्पन्नमाडिदनु ऎंब कथॆयिदॆ ऎंदु सायणरु रुद्रन मत्तु मरुत्तुगळ पितापुत्र
संबंधवन्नु तिळिसिद्दारॆ. मत्तु, मेलिन २–३४–२ ने ऋक्किनल्लि हेळिरुव कथॆयु तैत्तिरीय
संहितॆयल्लियू उक्तवागिरुवुदरिंद अल्लिन वाक्यवन्नू उदहरिसिद्दारॆ.
पृश्नियै वै पयसो मरुतो जाताः ।
(तै. सं. २–२–११–४)
आदुदरिंदले अनेक कडॆगळल्लि मरुत्तुगळिगॆ रुद्रपुत्ररॆंदे संबोधनॆयिदॆ. उदाहरणॆगॆ—
प्र ये शुंभंते जनयो न सप्तयो यामनु द्रस्य सूनवः सुदंससः ।
(ऋ. सं. १–८५–१)
इदं पित्रे मरुतामुच्यते वचः स्वादोः स्वादीयो रुद्राय वर्धनः ।
रास्वा च नो अमृत मर्तभोजनं त्मने तोकाय तनयाय मृळ ॥
(ऋ. सं. १–११४–६)

nānāvarṇavuḷḷa pṛthviyu hiṃdè gorūpavannu dharisiddāga maheśanu èttina rūpadiṃda maruttu
gaḷannu utpannamāḍidanu èṃba kathèyidè èṃdu sāyaṇaru rudrana mattu maruttugaḷa pitāputra
saṃbaṃdhavannu tiḷisiddārè. mattu, melina 2-34-2 ne ṛkkinalli heḷiruva kathèyu taittirīya
saṃhitèyalliyū uktavāgiruvudariṃda allina vākyavannū udaharisiddārè.
pṛśniyai vai payaso maruto jātāḥ |
(tai. saṃ. 2-2-11-4)
ādudariṃdale aneka kaḍègaḷalli maruttugaḷigè rudraputrarèṃde saṃbodhanèyidè. udāharaṇègè—
pra ye śuṃbhaṃte janayo na saptayo yāmanu drasya sūnavaḥ sudaṃsasaḥ |
(ṛ. saṃ. 1-85-1)

> *idaṃ pitre marutāmucyate vacaḥ svādoḥ svādīyo rudrāya vardhanaḥ |*
> *rāsvā ca no amṛta martabhojanaṃ tmane tokāya tanayāya mṛḷa ‖*
> *(ṛ. saṃ. 1-114-6)*

> ऎंब ऋक्कुगळल्लियू हीगॆये, १–१६८–९ ; २–३३–१ ; मुंताद अनेक कडॆगळल्लियू मरुत्तु
> गळिगॆ रुद्रपुत्ररॆंब विशेषणविदॆ. मेलॆ उदहरिसिरुव १–११४–६ ने ऋक्कन्नु विवरिसुवाग
> सायणरु इन्नॊंदु कथॆयन्नु हेळिद्दारॆ.
> रुद्रस्य च मरुतां पितृत्वमेवमाख्यायते । पुरा कदाचिदिंद्रोऽसुरान्
> जिगाय । तदानीं दितिरसुरमाता इंद्रहननसमर्थं पुत्रं कामयमाना तपसा भर्तुः सकाशाद्गर्भं
> लेभे । इमं वृत्तांतमवगच्छन्निंद्रो
> वज्रहस्तः सन् सूक्ष्मरूपो भूत्वा तस्या उदरं प्रविश्य तं गर्भं
> सप्तधा बिभेद । पुनरप्येकैकं सप्तखंडमकरोत् । ते सर्वे गर्भैकदेशायोनेनिर्गत्य अरुदन् ।
> एतस्मिन्नसवरे लीलार्थं गच्छंतौ पार्वतीपरमेश्वरौ इमान् ददृशतुः । महेशं प्रति पार्वती
> एवमवोचत् ।
> इमे मांसखंडा यथा प्रत्येकं पुत्राः संपद्यतामेवं त्वया
> कार्यं मयि चेत्प्रीतिरस्तीति । स च महेश्वरस्तान् समानरूपान्
> समानवयसः समानालंकारान् पुत्रान् कृत्वा गौरै प्रददौ तवेमे
> पुत्राः संत्विति । अतः सर्वेषु मारुतेषु सूक्तेषु मरुतो रुद्रपुत्रा
> इति स्तूयंते । रौद्रेषु च मरुतां पिता रुद्र इति ।

> *èṃba ṛkkugaḷalliyū hīgèye, 1-168-9 ; 2-33-1 ; muṃtāda aneka*
> *kaḍègaḷalliyū maruttu*
> *gaḷigè rudraputrarèṃba viśeṣaṇavidè. melè udaharisiruva 1-114-6 ne*
> *ṛkkannu vivarisuvāga*
> *sāyaṇaru innòṃdu kathèyannu heḷiddārè.*
> *rudrasya ca marutāṃ pitṛtvamevamākhyāyate | purā kadācidiṃdro*
> *'surān*
> *jigāya | tadānīṃ ditirasuramātā iṃdrahananasamarthaṃ putraṃ*
> *kāmayamānā tapasā bhartuḥ sakāśādgarbhaṃ lebhe | imaṃ*
> *vṛttāṃtamavagacchanniṃdro*
> *vajrahastaḥ san sūkṣmarūpo bhūtvā tasyā udaraṃ praviśya taṃ*
> *garbhaṃ*
> *saptadhā bibheda | punarapyekaikaṃ saptakhaṃḍamakarot | te sarve*
> *garbhaikadeśāyonenirgatya arudan | etasminnasavare līlārthaṃ*
> *gacchaṃtau pārvatīparameśvarau imān dadṛśatuḥ | maheśaṃ prati*
> *pārvatī evamavocat |*
> *ime māṃsakhaṃḍā yathā pratyekaṃ putrāḥ saṃpadyatāmevaṃ tvayā*

> *kāryaṃ mayi cetprītirastīti | sa ca maheśvarastān samānarūpān samānavayasaḥ samānālaṃkārān putrān kṛtvā gaurai pradadau taveme putrāḥ saṃtviti | ataḥ sarveṣu māruteṣu sūkteṣu maruto rudraputrā iti stūyaṃte | raudreṣu ca marutāṃ pitā rudra iti |*

> पूर्वदल्लि ऒंदुसल इंद्रनु असुररन्नु जयिसिदनु. आग असुर मातॆयाद दितियु इंद्रनन्नु कॊल्ललु समर्थनाद ऒब्ब पुत्रनन्नु पडॆयबेकॆंब आसॆयिंद तपस्सन्नाचरिसि तन्न पतिय अनुग्रहदिंद गर्भवन्नु हॊंदिदळु. इंद्रनु ई समाचारवन्नु तिळिदु वज्रायुधवन्नु हिडिदु कॊंडु सूक्ष्मरूपवागि बंदु अवळ हॊट्टॆयन्नु प्रवेशिसि आ गर्भवन्नु एळु भागगळागि सीळिदनु पुनः एळेळु तुंडुगळन्नागि माडिदनु. आग अवॆल्लवू हॊरक्कॆ बंदु अळुत्तिद्दुवु. आग लीलार्थवागि पार्वती परमेश्वररिब्बरू संचरिसुत्तिद्दाग इवन्नु नोडि, पार्वतियु मरुकगॊंडु महेश्वरनन्नु कुरितु अवॆल्लवन्नू मक्कळन्नागि परिवर्तिबेकॆंदु बेडिदळु. आग ईश्वरनु अवॆल्लवन्नु ऒंदे रूपवुळ्ळवरन्नागियू, ऒंदे वयस्सुळ्ळवरन्नागियू, ऒंदे अलंकारवुळ्ळवरन्नागियू माडि पुत्ररूपराद अवरन्नु इवु निन्न पुत्रागिरलि ऎंदु गौरिगॆ कॊट्टनु. आदुदरिंद मरुत्तूक्तगळल्लॆल्ला मरुत्तुगळिगॆ रुद्रपुत्ररॆंदू, रुद्रसूक्तगळल्लि रुद्रनिगॆ मरुत्तुगळ पितृवॆंदू हेळुव क्रमविदॆयॆंदु सायणरु ई कथॆयन्नु हेळिरुत्तारॆ.
> सहस्रसावे—सहस्रं सूयते चेति सहस्रसावोऽश्वमेधः । ई यागदल्लि सोमाभिषवकर्मवु अनेकसल (सहस्रशब्दक्कॆ अनेकवॆंबर्थ) नडॆयुवुदरिंद (अथवा अनेक पशुगळिरुवुदरिंद) सहस्रसाववॆंदरॆ अश्वमेधयागवॆंदु भाष्यकाररु अर्थविवरणॆमाडिद्दारॆ.

> *pūrvadalli òṃdusala iṃdranu asurarannu jayisidanu. āga asura mātèyāda ditiyu iṃdra*
> *nannu kòllalu samarthanāda òbba putranannu paḍèyabekèṃba āsèyiṃda tapassannācarisi tanna patiya*
> *anugrahadiṃda garbhavannu hòṃdidaḷu. iṃdranu ī samācāravannu tiḷidu vajrāyudhavannu hiḍidu*
> *kòṃḍu sūkṣmarūpavāgi baṃdu avaḷa hòṭṭèyannu praveśisi ā garbhavannu eḷu bhāgagaḷāgi sīḷidanu*
> *punaḥ eḷeḷu tuṃḍugaḷannāgi māḍidanu. āga avèllavū hòrakkè baṃdu aḷuttidduvu. āga līlārthavāgi*
> *pārvatī parameśvararibbarū saṃcarisuttiddāga ivannu noḍi, pārvatiyu marukagòṃḍu maheśvara*
> *nannu kuritu avèllavannū makkaḷannāgi parivartibekèṃdu beḍidaḷu. āga īśvaranu avèllavannu òṃde*
> *rūpavuḷḷavarannāgiyū, òṃde vayassuḷḷavarannāgiyū, òṃde alaṃkāravuḷḷavarannāgiyū māḍi*
> *putrarūparāda avarannu ivu ninna putrarāgirali èṃdu gaurigè kòṭṭanu.*

> *ādudariṃda maruttūkta*
> *gaḷallèllā maruttugaḷigè rudraputrarèṃdū, rudrasūktagaḷalli rudranigè maruttugaḷa pitṛvèṃdū*
> *heḷuva kramavidèyèṃdu sāyaṇaru ī kathèyannu heḷiruttārè.*
> *sahasrasāve—sahasraṃ sūyate ceti sahasrasāvo 'śvamedhaḥ | ī yāgadalli*
> *somābhiṣavakarmavu anekasala (sahasraśabdakkè anekavèṃbartha) naḍèyuvudariṃda (athavā aneka paśu*
> *gaḷiruvudariṃda) sahasrasāvavèṃdarè aśvamedhayāgavèṃdu*
> *bhāṣyakāraru arthavivaraṇèmāḍiddārè.*

Summary

"O Indra, these Bhojas who perform the sacrifice are Saudāsa kṣatriyas; their priests are the Aṅgirases of diverse forms, Medhātithi and others; and the sons (putrāsaḥ) of the asura Rudra, who is stronger even than the gods, are the heroic, mighty Maruts. All these, giving to me, Viśvāmitra, at the sahasrasāva (the Aśvamedha, in which a thousand are pressed), magnificent riches (maghāni), prolong life, that is, living and food, and make them increase." (The rest of the block is grammar: the visarjanīya of दिवस्पुत्रास (*divasputrāsa*) in the Saṃhitā, ददतः (*dadataḥ*), तिरंते (*tiraṃte*).)

In the Kannada text of this block, Sāyaṇa is said to state, as the story, that when the many-coloured earth had once taken the form of a cow, Maheśa became a bull and begot the Maruts in her; thus he shows the father–son relation of Rudra and the Maruts. Since the story told in Ṛk 2-34-2 is also found in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, the sentence there is cited: पृश्नियै वै पयसो मरुतो जाताः (*pṛśniyai vai payaso maruto jātāḥ*) (Tai. Saṃ. 2-2-11-4). Hence in many places the Maruts are addressed as sons of Rudra. As an example, the Ṛk प्र ये शुंभंते जनयो न सप्तयो यामनु द्रस्य सूनवः सुदंससः । (*pra ye śuṃbhaṃte janayo na saptayo yāmanu drasya sūnavaḥ sudaṃsasaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-85-1) and the Ṛk इदं पित्रे मरुतामुच्यते वचः स्वादोः स्वादीयो रुद्राय वर्धनः । रास्वा च नो अमृत मर्तभोजनं त्मने तोकाय तनयाय मृळ ॥ (*idaṃ pitre marutāmucyate vacaḥ svādoḥ svādīyo rudrāya vardhanaḥ | rāsvā ca no amṛta martabhojanaṃ tmane tokāya tanayāya mṛḷa ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-114-6) are cited.

?83

In these Ṛks, and likewise in 1-168-9, 2-33-1 and many other places, the Maruts have the epithet "sons of Rudra". In explaining Ṛk 1-114-6 cited above, Sāyaṇa tells another story. Sāyaṇa's Sanskrit: Rudra's and the Maruts' fatherhood is told thus. Once long ago Indra conquered the Asuras. Then Diti, the mother of the Asuras, desiring a son able to kill Indra, obtained by austerity a conception from her husband. Learning this, Indra, vajra in hand, became subtle in form, entered her womb and split that embryo into seven; again he made each of them into seven pieces. All of them came out through a part of the womb and wept. At that time Pārvatī and Parameśvara, going about in play, saw them. Pārvatī said to Maheśa that if he loved her, he should so act that these pieces of flesh become sons, one each. And Maheśvara, making them sons of the same form, the same age and the same ornaments, gave them to Gaurī: "Let these be your sons." Therefore in all Marut-hymns the Maruts are praised as sons of Rudra, and in the Rudra-hymns Rudra is the father of the Maruts.

(Kannada account of the story.) Once in the past Indra conquered the Asuras. Then Diti, mother of the Asuras, desiring a son able to kill Indra, practised austerity and by her husband's favour conceived. Indra, learning this, took up the thunderbolt, came in subtle form, entered her belly and split the embryo into seven parts, then again into seven pieces each. Then all of them came out and wept. As Pārvatī and Parameśvara were wandering in sport, they saw them; Pārvatī, moved to pity, begged Maheśvara to turn them all into children. Īśvara made them all of one form, one age and one ornament, and gave those who had become sons to Gaurī, saying, "Let these be your sons." Hence it is the practice in the Marut-hymns to call the Maruts sons of Rudra, and in the Rudra-hymns to call Rudra the father of the Maruts; Sāyaṇa tells this story for that reason.

सहस्रसावे—सहस्रं सूयते चेति सहस्रसावोऽश्वमेधः (*sahasrasāve—sahasraṃ sūyate ceti sahasrasāvo 'śvamedhaḥ*). Since in this sacrifice the Soma-pressing rite is performed many times (the word *sahasra* meaning "many"), or because there are many animals, the commentator explains *sahasrasāva* as the Aśvamedha sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) इमे (*ime*)—the sacrificers who perform the sacrifice here
- भोजाः (*bhojāḥ*)—sons of the kṣatriya named Sudāsa
- विरूपाः (*virūpāḥ*)—of diverse forms, Medhātithi and others
- अंगिरसः (*aṃgirasaḥ*)—the Aṅgirases (are the priests of these sacrificers)
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—than the gods
- असुरस्य (*asurasya*)—of Rudra, who has greater strength
- पुत्रासः (*putrāsaḥ*)—sons
- वीराः (*vīrāḥ*)—the Maruts, endowed with strength
- विश्वामित्राय (*viśvāmitrāya*)—to me, Viśvāmitra
- सहस्रसावे (*sahasrasāve*)—in this Aśvamedha sacrifice
- मघानि (*maghāni*)—riches
- ददतः (*dadataḥ*)—giving
- आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—life
- प्रति तिरंते (*prati tiraṃte*)—they increase

Gist

O Indra, the sacrificers who perform the sacrifice here are the sons of the kṣatriya named Sudāsa. The Aṅgirases of diverse forms, Medhātithi and others, are priests (ṛtvik) of this sacrificer. The Maruts, sons of Rudra, who has greater strength than the gods, and endowed with strength, giving wealth and riches to me, Viśvāmitra, in this Aśvamedha sacrifice, increase my life.[781]

English translation

These (sacrificers) are the Bhojas, of whom the diversified Angirasas (are the priests) : and the heroic sons of the expeller (of the foes of the gods) from heaven, bestowing riches upon Vishwamitra at the sacrifice of a thousand (victims), prolong (his) life.

Special Topics

भोजाः (*bhojāḥ*)—सौदासः क्षत्रियाः (*saudāsaḥ kṣatriyāḥ*). Sāyaṇa explains this as "sons of the king named Sudāsa". Sudāsa is the son of a well-known king named Pijavana. In the Viṣṇu Purāṇa it is explained that there was a king named Sudāsa in the Solar dynasty, that another king of the same name was in the Lunar dynasty, and that another king of the same name was in the Lunar dynasty as son of the king Divodāsa.[?82]. The name of Divodāsa is mentioned in many places in the Ṛgveda.

Concerning the king Sudāsa, the commentator, in explaining Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-112-9, has told an earlier story:

अत्रापीतिहासमाचक्षते । सुदासनामा पैजवनो राजा यस्य विश्वामित्रः पुरोहितो बभूव । स यष्टु कामः सारवत्प्रभूतं धनमश्विन् ययाचे। तस्मै रथेनानीयाश्विस्सौ ददुतुरिति ॥ (*atrāpītihāsamācakṣate | sudāsanāmā paijavano rājā yasya viśvāmitraḥ purohito babhūva | sa yaṣṭu kāmaḥ sāravatprabhūtaṃ dhanamaśvin yayāce| tasmai rathenānīyāśvissau daduturiti ‖*)

That is: Viśvāmitra was the priest of the king's son named Sudāsa, the son of Pijavana. That king wished to perform a sacrifice with Viśvāmitra's help, and for that he prayed to the Aśvin deities to provide abundant wealth. They brought wealth filling their chariot and furnished it to him. This is the story. The seer Praskaṇva states it in the Ṛk

सुदासे दस्रा वसु बिभ्रता रथे पृक्षो वहतमश्विना । (*sudāse dasrā vasu bibhratā rathe pṛkṣo vahatamaśvinā |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-47-6).

The Nirukta author also speaks of him briefly: विश्वामित्रऋषिः सुदासः पैजवनस्य पुरोहितो बभूव । पैजवनः पिजवनस्य पुत्रः (*viśvāmitrarṣiḥ sudāsaḥ paijavanasya purohito babhūva | paijavanaḥ pijavanasya putraḥ*) (Ni. 2-24). That is, from this Nirukta sentence we learn that Viśvāmitra was the priest of Sudāsa, the son of Pijavana, and that Sudāsa got help from him. From this derivation it can be said that Divodāsa was Sudāsa's grandfather.

From the Ṛks

अर्णांसि चित्पप्रधाना सुदास इंद्रो गाध्यान्यकृणोत्सुपारा । (*arṇāṃsi citpapradhānā sudāsa iṃdro gādhyānyakṝṇotsupārā* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-18-5)

and

कर्ता सुदासे अह वा उ लोकं दाता वसु मुहुरा दाशुषे भूत् । (*kartā sudāse aha vā u lokaṃ dātā vasu muhurā dāśuṣe bhūt* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-20-2)

and the like, we learn that with the help of Indra and the other deities Sudāsa defeated ten kings and flourished.

In the Ṛk

महा ऋषिर्देवजा देवजातोऽस्तभ्ना त्सिंधुमर्णव नृचक्षाः । विश्वामित्रो यदवहत्सुदासमप्रियायत कुशिकेभिरिंद्रः ॥ (*mahā ṛṣirdevajā devajāto 'stabhnā tsiṃdhumarṇava nṛcakṣāḥ | viśvāmitro yadavahatsudāsamapriyāyata kuśikebhiriṃdraḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-53-9)

Sudāsa's military expedition, together with his priest Viśvāmitra, on the banks of the rivers Vipāś and Śutudri is described.

In the Ṛk

त्वं धृष्णो धृषता वीतहव्यं प्रावो विश्वाभिरूतिभिः सुदासं । प्र पौरुकुत्सिं त्रसदस्युमावः क्षेत्रसाता वृत्रहत्येषु पूरुं ॥ (*tvaṃ dhṛṣṇo dhṛṣatā vītahavyaṃ prāvo viśvābhirūtibhiḥ sudāsaṃ | pra paurukutsiṃ trasadasyumāvaḥ kṣetrasātā vṛtrahatyeṣu pūruṃ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-19-3)

the name of Sudāsa is mentioned along with Trasadasyu, the son of Purukutsa. Both are praised as worthy of the protection of Indra and the others, and therefore as having received the protections of the deities.

In the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa:

प्रोवाच वसिष्ठः सुदासे पैजवनाय ते ह ते सर्व एव महज्जग्मुः । (*provāca vasiṣṭhaḥ sudāse paijavanāya te ha te sarva eva mahajjagmuḥ* |) (Ai. Brā. 35-8)

From this sentence we learn that Vasiṣṭha was Sudāsa's priest, that Sudāsa was honoured even by Vasiṣṭha, the greatest of the seers, and that he attained high rank.

At the Aśvamedha sacrifice performed by that Sudāsa, Viśvāmitra was the chief priest; Medhātithi and others, the Aṅgiras seers and still other seers were officiants. The Marut deities, sons of Rudra, were also there. It is explained here that all of them bestowed abundant wealth, food and long life on the seer Viśvāmitra.

दिवः पुत्रासः असुरस्य वीराः—देवेभ्योऽपि बलवतो रुद्रस्य पुत्रा वीरा बलवंतो मरुतः । (*divaḥ putrāsaḥ asurasya vīrāḥ—devebhyo 'pi balavato rudrasya putrā vīrā balavaṃto marutaḥ* |). Here, explaining the words *divaḥ* and *asurasya* as "of Rudra, who is stronger than even the gods", he says that the Maruts are the sons of Rudra. That the Maruts are Rudra's sons is well known from the Śruti.

As the Ṛk

रुद्रो यद्वो मरुतो रुक्मवक्षसो वृषाजनि पृश्न्याः शुक्र ऊधनि । (*rudro yadvo maruto rukmavakṣaso vṛṣājani pṛśnyāḥ śukra ūdhani* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-34-2)

says, there is a well-known story that the Maruts were born in Pṛśni as sons of Rudra; therefore this epithet is used most often whenever they are addressed. In explaining this Ṛk Sāyaṇācārya tells yet another story:

पृश्निर्नानावर्णा इयं भूमिः पुरा गोरूपधरासीत् । तस्यां महेशो वृषो भूत्वा मरुत उत्पादयामासेत्याचक्षते । (*pṛśnirnānāvarṇā iyaṃ bhūmiḥ purā gorūpadharāsīt* | *tasyāṃ maheśo vṛṣo bhūtvā maruta utpādayāmāsetyācakṣate* |).

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

रू॒पंरू॑पं म॒घवा॑ बोभवीति मा॒याः कृ॑ण्वा॒नस्त॒न्वं१॒॑ परि॒ स्वाम् ।
त्रिर्यद्दि॒वः परि॑ मुहू॒र्तमागा॒त्स्वैर्मन्त्रै॒रनृ॑तुपा ऋ॒तावा॑ ॥ ८ ॥

> *rūpaṃrūpaṃ maghavā bobhavīti māyāḥ kṛṇvānastanvaṃ pari svām |*
> *triryaddivaḥ pari muhūrtamāgātsvairmantrairanṛtupā ṛtāvā ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> रूपंरूपं । मघवा । बोभवीति । मायाः । कृष्णानः । तन्वं । परि । स्वां ।
> त्रिः । यत् । दिवः । परि । मुहूर्तं । आ । अगात् । स्वैः । मंत्रैः । अनृतुपाः
> ऋतावा ॥ ८ ॥

> *rūpaṃrūpaṃ | maghavā | bobhavīti | māyāḥ | kṛṣṇānaḥ | tanvaṃ | pari | svāṃ |*
> *triḥ | yat | divaḥ | pari | muhūrtaṃ | ā | agāt | svaiḥ | maṃtraiḥ | anṛtupāḥ*
> *ṛtāvā ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मघना धनवानिंद्रो रूपंदूपं यद्यद्रूपं कामयते तत्तद्रूपं
> बोभवीति । भृशं प्राप्नोति तत्तद्रूपात्मको भवति । तत्र कारणमुच्यते । माया
> अनेकरूपग्रहणसामर्थ्योपेताः कृष्णानः कुर्वाणः स्वां तन्नं स्वकीयां तनूं
> परि । पंचम्यर्थे । स्वस्माच्छरीरान्नानाविधानि शरीराणि निर्मिमिते । यद्वा । स्वां
> तनूं नानाविधरूपोपेतां करोति । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । इंद्रो मायाभिः
> पुरुरूपः । ऋग्वे. ६–४७–१८ । इति । यद्यस्मात्स्वैर्मंत्रैः स्वकीयैः
> स्तुतिलक्षणैर्वकिराहूतोऽनृतपाः । न केवलमृतुष्टेव पिबति किंत्वनृतुष्पपि। बहुशः सोमं
> पिबन्नित्यर्थः । ऋतावा सत्यवान् तादृश इंद्रो दिवः स्वर्गलोकात्परि मुहूर्तमेकस्मिन्नेव मुहूर्ते
> नानादेशवर्तिषु यज्ञेषु तत्रापि त्रिः त्रिषु सवनेष्वागात् ।
> आगच्छति ॥ बोभवीति । भवतेर्यज् लुकि तिपि यजो वेतीडागमः । निघातः । अगात्!
> इणो लुजि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ॥

> *maghanā dhanavānimdro rūpaṃdūpaṃ yadyadrūpaṃ kāmayate tattadrūpaṃ*
> *bobhavīti | bhṛśaṃ prāpnoti tattadrūpātmako bhavati | tatra kāraṇamucyate | māyā*
> *anekarūpagrahaṇasāmarthyopetāḥ kṛṣṇānaḥ kurvāṇaḥ svāṃ tannaṃ svakīyāṃ tanūṃ*
> *pari | paṃcamyarthe | svasmāccharīrānnānāvidhāni śarīrāṇi nirmimite | yadvā | svāṃ*
> *tanūṃ nānāvidharūpopetāṃ karoti | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | iṃdro māyābhiḥ*

> *pururūpaḥ | ṛgve. 6-47-18 | iti | yadyasmātsvairmaṃtraiḥ svakīyaiḥ stutilakṣaṇairvākairāhūto 'nṛtapāḥ | na kevalamṛtuṣṭeva pibati kiṃtvanṛtuṣpapi| bahuśaḥ somaṃ*
> *pibannityarthaḥ | ṛtāvā satyavān tādṛśa iṃdro divaḥ svargalokātpari muhūrtamekasminneva muhūrte nānādeśavartiṣu yajñeṣu tatrāpi triḥ triṣu savaneṣvāgāt |*
> *āgacchati ‖ bobhavīti | bhavateryaj luki tipi yajo vetīḍāgamaḥ | nighātaḥ | agāt!*
> *iṇo luji rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Maghavan, the wealthy Indra, बोभवीति (*bobhavīti*) — repeatedly attains, becomes of that very form — whatever form he wishes. The reason is given: *māyāḥ*, powers endowed with the capacity of assuming many forms; *kṛṣṇānaḥ*, making (them); *svāṃ tanvam*, his own body; *pari* is in the sense of the ablative: from his own body he fashions bodies of many kinds. Or else: he makes his own body possessed of many kinds of forms. And so the mantra text says: "Indra is of many forms through his māyās" (Ṛg. 6-47-18). *Yat*: since, called by his own mantras, namely words of the nature of praise, he is *anṛtupāḥ*: he drinks not only in the proper season but also out of season; the meaning is that he drinks Soma many times. *Ṛtāvā*: truthful. Such an Indra comes from heaven, in one and the same moment, to the sacrifices in different places, and there too three times, to the three pressings.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवा (*maghavā*)—Indra, the wealthy one
- रूपंरूपं (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ*)—forms of many kinds
- बोभनीति (*bobhanīti*)—appears assuming them
- मायाः (*māyāḥ*)—making (them) into powers of many kinds
- कृष्णानः (*kṛṣṇānaḥ*)—doing
- स्वां तन्नं (*svāṃ tannaṃ*)—his own body
- परि (*pari*)—different from the original form
- यत् (*yat*)—by which same power
- स्वैः मंत्रैः (*svaiḥ maṃtraiḥ*)—by the mantras that praise him

- अनृतुपाः (*anṛtupāḥ*)—drinks Soma even when it is not the proper season
- ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*)—Indra, the truthful
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from the world of heaven
- महूर्तं (*mahūrtaṃ*)—in one single moment
- परि (*pari*)—taking place in various countries
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—at the time of the three pressings
- आगात् (*āgāt*)—comes

Gist

The wealthy Indra appears assuming forms of many kinds. Making them powers of many kinds, he makes his own body one of many forms, different from its original form. By that same power, called by the mantras that praise him, he drinks Soma even when it is not the proper season. The truthful Indra comes from the world of heaven in a single moment, to the sacrifices taking place in various countries, and at the time of the three pressings.

English translation

Maghavan becomes repeatedly (manifest) in various forms, practising delusions with respect to his own peculiar person; and invoked by his appropriate prayers, he comes in a moment from heaven to the three (daily rites), and, although observant of seasons, is the drinker (of the Soma) irrespective of season.

Special Topics

रूपंरूपं मघवा बोभवीति—धनवानिंद्रो यद्यद्रूपं कामयते तत्तद्रूपं प्राप्नोति, तत्तद्रूपात्मको भवति । (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ maghavā bobhavīti—dhanavāniṃdro yadyadrūpaṃ kāmayate tattadrūpaṃ prāpnoti, tattadrūpātmako bhavati |*). Indra, endowed with all lordship, takes on whatever forms he wishes whenever he wishes; that is, he becomes of that very form. On this point: some Asuras learned that Indra was sitting in the sacrificial enclosure of the seer Gṛtsamada, and lay in wait to kill him as soon as he came out. Indra learned of this plot, and when leaving the sacrificial ground he took on the form of the seer Gṛtsamada and went out. The Asuras, thinking that it was Gṛtsamada going, did not harm Indra. Afterwards the Asuras learned the fact. We have narrated this story in the introduction to this Maṇḍala.

मायाः कृष्णानः तन्वं परि स्वां-स्वस्माच्छरीरात् नानाविधानि शरीराणि निर्मिमाते । यद्वा स्वां तनूं नानाविधरूपोपेतां करोति । (*māyāḥ kṛṣṇānaḥ tanvaṃ pari svāṃ-svasmāccharīrāt nānāvidhāni śarīrāṇi nirmimāte | yadvā svāṃ tanūṃ nānāvidharūpopetāṃ karoti |*). Besides, Indra can fashion from his own body forms and bodies of many kinds, or can make his own body one possessed of many kinds of forms. On this point:

रूपंरूपं प्रतिरूपो बभूव तदस्य रूपं प्रतिचक्षणाय । इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते युक्ता ह्यस्य हरयः शता दश ॥ (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ pratirūpo babhūva tadasya rūpaṃ praticakṣaṇāya | iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate yuktā hyasya harayaḥ śatā daśa ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-18)

This Ṛk the commentator has given as an example. Its main sense is that Indra is able to assume forms of many kinds by his powers of illusion. As follows:

यत् स्वैः मंत्रैः अनृतुपाः ऋतावा दिवः मुहूर्तं परि त्रिः आगात्— सत्यवान् इंद्र स्वर्गलोकात्सरि एकस्मिन्नेन मुहूर्ते नानादेशवर्शिषु यज्ञेषु तत्रापि त्रिषु सवनकालेषु आगच्छति । (*yat svaiḥ maṃtraiḥ anṛtupāḥ ṛtāvā divaḥ muhūrtaṃ pari triḥ āgāt— satyavān iṃdra svargalokātsari ekasminnena muhūrte nānādeśavarśiṣu yajñeṣu tatrāpi triṣu savanakāleṣu āgacchati |*). In the many sacrifices performed by many sacrificers in various countries, and at the three pressing-times of each of those sacrifices, as soon as he is called by the mantras they recite, Indra at one and the same time comes from heaven in an instant and drinks the Soma. The sense is that in this way, to go to many sacrifices at one time, Indra goes taking on many forms.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हाँ ऋषि॑र्देव॒जा दे॒वजू॒तोऽस्त॑भ्ना॒त्सिन्धु॑मर्ण॒वं नृ॒चक्षा॑ः ।
वि॒श्वामि॑त्रो॒ यदव॑हत्सु॒दास॒मप्रि॑यायत कुशि॒केभि॒रिन्द्र॑ः ॥ ९ ॥

> *mahā~ ṛṣirdevajā devajūto 'stabhnātsindhumarṇavaṃ nṛcakṣāḥ |*
> *viśvāmitro yadavahatsudāsamapriyāyata kuśikebhirindraḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महान् । ऋषिः । देवजाः। देवजूतः । अस्तभ्नात् । सिंधुं । अर्णवं । नृचक्षाः।
> विश्वामित्रः । यत् । अवहत् । सुदासं। अप्रियायत । कुशिकेभिः । इंद्रः ॥ ९ ॥

> *mahān | ṛṣiḥ | devajāḥ| devajūtaḥ | astabhnāt | siṃdhuṃ | arṇavaṃ | nṛcakṣāḥ|*
> *viśvāmitraḥ | yat | avahat | sudāsaṃ| apriyāyata | kuśikebhiḥ | iṃdraḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> महान् तपसातिशयितसामर्थ्यवानृषिरतींद्रियार्थद्रष्टा देवजा द्योतमानानां तेजसां जनयिता
> देवजूतस्तैस्तेजोभिराकृष्टो नृचक्षा नृणां कर्मनेत्यणामध्वयार्वादीनामुपद्रष्टा स
> विश्वामितोर्णवमुदकवंतं सिंधुं विपाट्–

> *mahān tapasātiśayitasāmarthyavānṛṣiratīṃdriyārthadraṣṭā devajā*
> *dyotamānānāṃ tejasāṃ janayitā devajūtastaistejobhirākṛṣṭo nṛcakṣā*
> *nṛṇāṃ karmanetyaṇāmadhvayārvādīnāmupadraṣṭā sa*
> *viśvāmitorṇavamudakavaṃtaṃ siṃdhuṃ vipāṭ-*

> च्युतद्रोभिः संभेदमस्तभ्नात् । निरुद्धवेगमकरोत् । किंच स विश्वामित्रः सुदासं
> पैजवनं राजानं यद्यदाहवत् अयाजयत् तदानीमिंद्रः कुशिकेभिः कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्नैर्युषिभिः
> सहाप्रियायत । प्रिय इवाचरत् ॥ अवहत् । वह प्रापण इत्यस्य
> लजि रूपं । यद्योगादनिघातः । अप्रियायत । प्रिय इवाचरतीत्यर्थे कर्तुः
> क्यज् सलोपश्चेति क्यज् । तदंताल्लज रूपं । पादादित्पादनिघातः ॥

> *cyutadrobhiḥ saṃbhedamastabhnāt | niruddhavegamakarot | kiṃca sa viśvāmitraḥ sudāsaṃ*
> *paijavanaṃ rājānaṃ yadyadāhavat ayājayat tadānīmiṃdraḥ kuśikebhiḥ*
> *kuśikagotrotpannairyuṣibhiḥ sahāpriyāyata | priya ivācarat ‖ avahat | vaha prāpaṇa ityasya*
> *laji rūpaṃ | yadyogādanighātaḥ | apriyāyata | priya ivācaratītyarthe kartuḥ*
> *kyaj salopaśceti kyaj | tadaṃtāllaja rūpaṃ | pādāditpādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Mahān: great, possessed of surpassing power through austerity; *ṛṣi*: seer of things beyond the senses. *Devajāḥ*: the begetter of shining brilliances. *Devajūtaḥ*: drawn by those brilliances. *Nṛcakṣāḥ*: the overseer of the rites of men, that is, of the adhvaryus and others. That Viśvāmitra, the water-full river (sindhu), Vipāś — here the text breaks off at the end of the window.

Sāyaṇa continues the explanation of the ṛk: the great seer, who has surpassing power through austerity, who sees what lies beyond the senses, who is the begetter of shining lights, and who is drawn by those lights, is नृचक्षाः (*nṛcakṣāḥ*), the overseer of the leaders of rites, the adhvaryus and others. This Viśvāmitra checked the water-filled river by the meeting of the Vipāś and the Śutudrī, with the waters flowing in confluence, and made its flow stop. Further, when Viśvāmitra made Sudās, the son of Pijavana, the king, perform a sacrifice, Indra with the Kuśikas, the ṛṣis born in the Kuśika line, acted as though he were friendly. The remainder of the block gives grammar: अवहत् (*avahat*) is a laṅ form of the root वह (*vaha*) "to convey"; अप्रियायत (*apriyāyata*) means "behaved as though dear" and is formed with kyac.

Word-to-word meaning

- महान् (*mahān*)—one who has gained surpassing power through austerity
- ऋषिः (*ṛṣiḥ*)—seer of what is beyond the senses
- देवजाः (*devajāḥ*)—the birthplace of shining lights

- देवजूतः (*devajūtaḥ*)—one whose form is attractive through the lights
- नृचक्षाः (*nṛcakṣāḥ*)—one who has as eyes the priests, the adhvaryus and others
- विश्वामित्रः (*viśvāmitraḥ*)—Viśvāmitra
- अर्णवं (*arṇavaṃ*)—filled with water
- सिंधुं (*siṃdhuṃ*)—the confluence of the streams of the rivers Vipāś and Śutudrī
- अस्तभ्नात् (*astabhnāt*)—stopped
- सुदासं (*sudāsaṃ*)—the king named Sudās
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- अवहत् (*avahat*)—he made him perform a sacrifice, then
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- कुशिकेभिः (*kuśikebhiḥ*)—with the ṛṣis born in the Kuśika line
- अप्रियायत (*apriyāyata*)—showed his affection

Gist

Viśvāmitra, who has gained surpassing power through austerity, who sees what is beyond the senses, who is the birthplace of shining lights, whose form is attractive through those lights, and who has as eyes the priests, the adhvaryus and others, checked the confluence of the water-filled streams of the Vipāś and Śutudrī. And when he made the king Sudās perform a sacrifice, Indra showed his affection together with the ṛṣis born in the Kuśika line.

English translation

The great Rishi, the generator of the gods, the attracted by the deities, the overlooker of the leaders (at holy rites), Vishwamitra arrested the watery stream when he sacrificed for Sudas ; Indra, with the Kushikas, was pleased.

Special Topics

Ṛṣi: अतींद्रियार्थद्रष्टा (*atīṃdriyārthadraṣṭā*). One who has the power, through the strength of his mantras and of his austerity, to know the many things that are not accessible to the outer senses or to the mind.

देवजाः (*devajāḥ*): द्योतमानानां तेजसां जनयिता (*dyotamānānāṃ tejasāṃ janayitā*). The birthplace of shining lights: one who shines with a rare radiance (or the radiance of Brahman).

In the face of one who knows Brahman, a rare radiance shines. Free of every kind of doubt, he is always at peace of mind through contentment and joy, and ever of joyful heart.

देवजूतः (*devajūtaḥ*)—one whose form is attractive through the divine radiance spoken of above. The meaning is that even his bodily form is pleasing to look at.

विश्वामित्रः यत् सुदासं कुशिकेभिः अवहत् इंद्रः अप्रियायत (*viśvāmitraḥ yat sudāsaṃ kuśikebhiḥ avahat iṃdraḥ apriyāyata*)—When the ṛṣi Viśvāmitra made the king Sudās perform the Aśvamedha sacrifice, Indra behaved like a most beneficial friend towards Viśvāmitra and towards his kinsmen, the other ṛṣis born in the Kuśika line. This is the meaning.

नृचक्षाः—कर्मनेतृणामध्वर्याद्वीनामुपध्रष्टा (*nṛcakṣāḥ—karmanetṛṇāmadhvaryādvīnāmupadhraṣṭā*). He is like a second eye to the priests, the adhvaryus and others, who carry out the sacrificial action; that is, he guides the rites they perform, knows everything, and is accounted the best of the priests.

सिंधुं अर्णवं अस्तभ्नात् (*siṃdhuṃ arṇavaṃ astabhnāt*)—He checked and stopped the streams of the rivers, full and flowing with flood-waters, that is, the Vipāś and the Śutudrī. There is an earlier story about this stopping of the river-streams by Viśvāmitra.

The ṛṣi Viśvāmitra was the family priest of the king Sudās, son of Pijavana. When Sudās performed the Aśvamedha sacrifice with Viśvāmitra's help, he gave Viśvāmitra much wealth as a fee. Taking the wealth the king had given, Viśvāmitra set out to go to his hermitage and came to the place of confluence of the rivers Vipāś and Śutudrī (the present Beas and Sutlej in the Punjab). Robbers, wanting to carry off the wealth he had with him, were following close behind him. Knowing this, Viśvāmitra tried by every means to cross these rivers lying across his path, but being in flood, rushing swiftly and very deep, they could not be crossed. Then the ṛṣi, praying to the rivers, praised them so that they might reduce their water and make it convenient for him to pass. So the story goes. This is what is indicated in the present ṛk. A detailed account of the matter is given in Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33; its substance is briefly set out here.

Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33-1 to 13 is quoted:

प्र पर्वतानामुशती उपस्थादश्वे इव विषिते हासमाने । गावेव शुभ्रे मातरा रिहाणे विपाट्टुतुद्री पयसा जवेते ॥ १ ॥ (*pra parvatānāmuśatī upasthādaśve iva viṣite hāsamāne | gāveva śubhre mātarā rihāṇe vipāṭṭutudrī payasā javete ‖ 1 ‖*)

इंद्रेषिते प्रसवं भिक्षमाणे अच्छा समुद्रं रथ्येव याथः । समाराणे ऊर्मिभिः पिन्वमानेअन्या वामन्यामप्येति शुभ्रे ॥ २ ॥ (*iṃdrèṣite prasavaṃ bhikṣamāṇe acchā samudraṃ rathyeva yāthaḥ | samārāṇe ūrmibhiḥ pinvamāneanyā vāmanyāmapyeti śubhre ‖ 2 ‖*)

The remaining verses of the hymn follow in the printed table, each line quoted separately:

Verse 3:

अच्छा सिंधुं मातृतमामयासं विपा शमुर्वीं सुभगामगन्म । (*acchā siṃdhuṃ mātṛtamāmayāsaṃ vipā śamurvīṃ subhagāmaganma |*)

वत्समिव मातरा संरिहाणे समानं योनिमनु संचरंती (*vatsamiva mātarā saṃrihāṇe samānaṃ yonimanu saṃcaraṃtī*)

Verse 4:

एना वयं पयसा पिन्नमाना अनु योनिं देवकृतं चरंतीः । (*enā vayaṃ payasā pinnamānā anu yoniṃ devakṛtaṃ caraṃtīḥ |*)

न वर्तने प्रसवः सर्गतक्तः किर्युविप्रो नद्यो जोहवीति (*na vartane prasavaḥ sargataktaḥ kiryuvipro nadyo johavīti*)

Verse 5:

रमध्यं मे वचसे सोम्याय ऋतावरीरुप मुहूर्तमेवैः । (*ramadhyaṃ me vacase somyāya ṛtāvarīrupa muhūrtamevaiḥ |*)

प्र सिंधुमच्छा बृहती मनीषावस्युरष्टे कुशिकस्य सूनुः (*pra siṃdhumacchā bṛhatī manīṣāvasyuraṣṭe kuśikasya sūnuḥ*)

Verse 6:

इंद्रो अस्मा अरदद्वजबाहुरपादन्वत्रं परिधिं नदीनां । (*iṃdro asmā aradadvajabāhurapādanvatraṃ paridhiṃ nadīnāṃ |*)

देवोऽनयत्नविता सुपाणिस्तस्य वयं प्रसवे याम उर्वीः (*devo 'nayatnavitā supāṇistasya vayaṃ prasave yāma urvīḥ*)

Verse 7:

प्रवाच्यं शश्वधा वीर्यं१तदिंद्रस्य कर्म यदहिं विवृश्चत् । (*pravācyaṃ śaśvadhā vīryaṃ1tadiṃdrasya karma yadahiṃ vivṛścat |*)

वि वज्रेण परिषदो जघानायन्नापोऽयनमिच्छमानाः । (*vi vajreṇa pariṣado jaghānāyannāpo 'yanamicchamānāḥ |*)

Verse 8:

एतद्वचो जरितर्मापि मृष्या आ यत्ते घोषानुत्तरा युगानि । (*etadvaco jaritarmāpi mṛṣyā ā yatte ghoṣānuttarā yugāni |*)

उक्षेषु कारो प्रति नो जुषस्व मा नो नि कः पुरुषत्रा नमस्ते (*ukṣeṣu kāro prati no juṣasva mā no ni kaḥ puruṣatrā namaste*)

Verse 9:

ओ षु स्वसारः कारवे शृणोत यौ वो दूरादनसा रथेन । (*o ṣu svasāraḥ kārave śṛṇota yau vo dūrādanasā rathena |*)

नि षू नमध्वं भवता सुपारा अधोअक्षाः सिंधवः स्क्रोत्याभिः (*ni ṣū namadhvaṃ bhavatā supārā adhoakṣāḥ siṃdhavaḥ skrotyābhiḥ*)

Verse 10:

आ ते कारो शृणवामा वचांसि ययाथ दूरादनसा रथेन । (*ā te kāro śṛṇavāmā vacāṃsi yayātha dūrādanasā rathena |*)

नि ते नंसै पीप्यानेव योषा मर्यायेव कन्या शश्वचै ते (*ni te naṃsai pīpyāneva yoṣā maryāyeva kanyā śaśvacai te*)

Verse 11:

यदंग त्वा भरताः संतरेयुर्गव्यन् ग्राम इषित इंद्रजूतः । (*yadaṃga tvā bharatāḥ saṃtareyurgavyan grāma iṣita iṃdrajūtaḥ |*)

अर्षादह प्रसवः सर्गतक्त आ वो वृणे सुमतिं यज्ञियानां (*arṣādaha prasavaḥ sargatakta ā vo vṛṇe sumatiṃ yajñiyānāṃ*)

Verse 12:

अतारिषुर्भरता गव्यवः समभक्त विप्रः सुमतिं नदीनां । (*atāriṣurbharatā gavyavaḥ samabhakta vipraḥ sumatiṃ nadīnāṃ |*)

प्र पिन्नध्वमिषयंतीः सुराधा आ वक्षणाः पृणध्वं यात शीभं (*pra pinnadhvamiṣayaṃtīḥ surādhā ā vakṣaṇāḥ pṛṇadhvaṃ yāta śībhaṃ*)

Verse 13:

उद्वै ऊर्मिः शम्या हंत्वापो योक्राणि मुंचत । (*udvai ūrmiḥ śamyā haṃtvāpo yokrāṇi muṃcata |*)

वादुष्कृत् वैनसाघ्न्य शूनमारतां (*vāduṣkṛt vainasāghnya śūnamāratāṃ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33-1 to 13)

Viśvāmitra prays to the rivers Vipāś and Śutudrī in this way: As horses, let loose from the bonds with which they were tied in the stable, come running swiftly, vying with one another; and as cows, wishing to lick their calves lovingly in remembrance of them, run to where the calves are; so the river Vipāś, full of water, and the river Śutudrī as well

come forth from the flanks of the mountains, wishing to reach the sea, and flow with a swift current. O rivers, you two flow together, cooling the surrounding regions with your waves, sent forth by Indra, asking his leave, and you flow deep towards the sea like two charioteers. Of you two, one joins the other.

O rivers, as mother cows, gathering together in a herd, run towards the cowshed that is their refuge, to smell and caress their calves, so you flow towards the sea, the common refuge of you both. Among you the river Śutudrī is the foremost among nourishing mothers; the Vipāś is of great form and fortunate. I come to the two of you and take refuge in you for nourishment.

The rivers said: (O Viśvāmitra), we two, named Vipāś and Śutudrī, satisfying the whole world with our abundant waters, flow aiming at the place of the sea appointed by the lord Indra. The effort of our flowing never ceases. With what wish in mind does this Viśvāmitra call us?

Viśvāmitra spoke again: O rivers full of water, grant my prayer, who have set out to fetch soma, and hold back your swift streams for a little while. O Śutudrī, I, the son of Kuśika, humbly pray to you with a great hymn of praise for my own protection.

The rivers: O Viśvāmitra, Indra, the thunderbolt in his hand, slew the demon in the form of a cloud, who stood encircling and obstructing our waters, and opened the gates of our flow. That Indra, the beholder of the world, of excellent hand, the shining one, made things favourable for our flowing. We, filled with abundant waters, flow obedient to his command.

Indra slew the demon in the form of a cloud, so that the waters might flow freely. This great deed and power of Indra is to be praised at all times and beyond measure. Indra slew with his thunderbolt the demons who spread around; thereafter the waters that had been held back flow, aiming at their destination.

O Viśvāmitra, singer of praise, never forget the words of praise that glorify us. You, the author of excellent śastra-mantras, serve us also in the prayers that take place in the sacrifices to come

and do not give occasion for harsh words about us among other men. Here is our homage to you.

Viśvāmitra: O rivers, like sisters, listen well to the prayer of me, the singer. I have come to your neighbourhood from a very distant region with a cart and a chariot. Reduce your flow. Let your current be below the axle of our cart; let your banks be such that I can cross easily.

The rivers: O Viśvāmitra, singer, we have heard your words of praise. You have come from a very distant region with a cart and a chariot. As a mother bends to give her child the breast, and as a young woman bends to make an embrace (a kiss) convenient for a man, so we lower our current and bow for you.

Viśvāmitra: O rivers, by your favour an opportunity to cross has arisen for me. By the same favour may all my kinsmen born in the Bharata line cross you, who are united in confluence. May the host of those born in the Bharata line, who wish to cross the water, are permitted by you, and are urged on by Indra, cross you. The enterprise of those who have set out to travel is permitted by you. I will recite in full your excellent praise, worthy of sacrifice.

O rivers, all those born in the Bharata line, desiring cattle, have crossed you. The wise Viśvāmitra, having obtained the favour of the rivers, praised them. O rivers, you who increase wealth of food and are endowed with excellent riches, fill with water also the tributaries, such as canals, that flow under your protection.

O Vipāś and Śutudrī, let the waves of your water not touch the neck-ropes of our vehicle, but flow below them. You who are free of sin, doers of good deeds, free of blame, do not take on a swollen flood until we have crossed you.

This very matter is indicated in the present ṛk.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

हं॒सा इ॑व कृणुथ॒ श्लोक॒मद्रि॑भि॒र्मद॑न्तो गी॒र्भिर॑ध्व॒रे सु॒
ते सचा॑ ।
दे॒वेभि॑र्विप्रा ऋषयो नृचक्षसो॒ वि पि॑बध्वं कुशिकाः
सो॒म्यं मधु॑ ॥ १० ॥

> *haṃsā iva kṛṇutha ślokamadribhirmadanto gīrbhiradhvare sute sacā |*
> *devebhirviprā ṛṣayo nṛcakṣaso vi pibadhvaṃ kuśikāḥ somyaṃ madhu ||*
> *10 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> हंसाः इव । कृणुथ । श्लोकं । अद्रिभिः । मदंतः । गीभिः । अध्वरे । सुते । सचा ।
> देवेभिः । विप्राः । ऋषयः । नृचक्षसः । वि । पिबध्वं । कुशिकाः । सोम्यं । मधु ॥

> *haṃsāḥ iva | kṛṇutha | ślokaṃ | adribhiḥ | madaṃtaḥ | gībhiḥ | adhvare | sute | sacā |*
> *devebhiḥ | viprāḥ | ṛṣayaḥ | nṛcakṣasaḥ | vi | pibadhvaṃ | kuśikāḥ | somyaṃ | madhu ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे विप्रा मेधाविनो हे ऋषयोऽतींद्रियार्थस्य द्रष्टारो हे नृचक्षसो
> नृणां कर्मनेतृणां विशेषेण द्रष्टारो हे कुशिकाः कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्ना रे पुत्रा
> अध्वरे यज्ञेऽद्रिभिग्रावभिः सोमेसुतेऽभिशुते सति गीर्भिर्मदंतः स्तुतिभिर्देवान्मादयंतो यूयं
> श्लोकं । श्लोक्यते शस्यतेऽनेनेति श्लोकः शस्त्रं । कृणुथ ।
> सम्यगुच्चारयत । तत्र दृष्टांतः । हंसा इव । यथा हंसाः सम्यक् शब्दं कुर्वंति
> तद्वत् । किंच देवेभिः सजा यष्टव्यदेवैः सहिता यूयं सोम्यं सोममयं
> मधु मधुकरं रसं वि पिबध्वं । परस्परव्यतिहारेण पिबत ॥ श्लोकं । श्लोकृ शब्दे ।
> करणे घञ् । इत्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । मदंतः । मदी हर्ष इत्यस्यांतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य
> व्यत्ययेन शप् । पिबध्वं पा पाने । कर्तरि कर्मव्यतिहार इत्यात्मनेपदं । सोम्यं
> सोमशब्दान्मये चेति यप्रत्ययः ॥

> *he viprā medhāvino he ṛṣayo 'tīṃdriyārthasya draṣṭāro he nṛcakṣaso*
> *nṛṇāṃ karmanetṛṇāṃ viśeṣeṇa draṣṭāro he kuśikāḥ kuśikagotrotpannā re putrā*
> *adhvare yajñe 'dribhigrāvabhiḥ somesute 'bhiśute sati gīrbhirmadaṃtaḥ stutibhirdevānmādayaṃto yūyaṃ ślokaṃ | ślokyate śasyate 'neneti ślokaḥ śastraṃ | kṛṇutha |*
> *samyaguccārayata | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | haṃsā iva | yathā haṃsāḥ samyak śabdaṃ kurvaṃti*
> *tadvat | kiṃca devebhiḥ sajā yaṣṭavyadevaiḥ sahitā yūyaṃ somyaṃ somamayaṃ*
> *madhu madhukaraṃ rasaṃ vi pibadhvaṃ | parasparavyatihāreṇa pibata ‖ ślokaṃ | ślokṛ śabde |*
> *karaṇe ghañ | ittvādādyudāttaḥ | madaṃtaḥ | madī harṣa ityasyāṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya*
> *vyatyayena śap | pibadhvaṃ pā pāne | kartari karmavyatihāra ityātmanepadaṃ | somyaṃ*
> *somaśabdānmaye ceti yapratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa addresses the Kuśikas: "O विप्रा (*viprā*), wise ones; O ऋषयः (*ṛṣayaḥ*), seers of what is beyond the senses; O नृचक्षसः (*nṛcakṣasaḥ*), special overseers of the leaders of rites; O कुशिकाः (*kuśikāḥ*), sons born in the Kuśika line! In the sacrifice, when soma has been pressed with the pressing stones, delighting the gods with your songs of praise, you utter the श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*)," that is, the śastra, so called because it is recited (श्लोक्यते शस्यतेऽनेनेति (*ślokyate śasyate 'neneti*)). कृणुथ (*kṛṇutha*) means "utter properly". The illustration is हंसा इव (*haṃsā iva*): as swans make a clear sound, so do you. Further, together with the gods who are to be worshipped, drink the soma-made, sweet, honey-like juice वि पिबध्वं (*vi pibadhvaṃ*), that is, drink with one another in turn. The rest of the block gives grammar of श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*), मदंतः (*madaṃtaḥ*), पिबध्वं (*pibadhvaṃ*) and सोम्यं (*somyaṃ*).

Word-to-word meaning

- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—O wise ones
- ऋषयः (*ṛṣayaḥ*)—O seers of what is beyond the senses
- नृचक्षासः (*nṛcakṣāsaḥ*)—O you who have as eyes the human beings who are the priests
- कुशिकाः (*kuśikāḥ*)—O great sages born in the Kuśika line
- अध्वरे (*adhvare*)—in the sacrifice
- अद्रिभिः (*adribhiḥ*)—with the pressing stones
- सुते (*sute*)—when soma has been pressed
- गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)—with words in the form of praise
- मदंतः (*madaṃtaḥ*)—gladdening the gods
- श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*)—the praise in the form of a śastra
- हंसा इव (*haṃsā iva*)—as swans make a pleasing sound
- कृणुथ (*kṛṇutha*)—recite
- देवेभिः सचा (*devebhiḥ sacā*)—you who are accompanied by the gods
- सोम्यं (*somyaṃ*)—having soma as its nature
- मधु (*madhu*)—sweet
- वि पिबध्वं (*vi pibadhvaṃ*)—drink the juice

Gist

O wise ones, seers of what lies beyond the senses, you who have the human priests as your eyes, you of the Kuśika lineage, great sages! When Soma has been pressed with the pressing-stones at the sacrifice, delight the gods with words in the form of praise. As swans make a pleasing sound, so you too recite the praise that takes the form of a śastra. Together with the gods, drink the juice that is of the nature of Soma and full of sweetness.

English translation

Sages and saints, overlookers of the leaders (of sacred rites), Kushikas, when the Soma is expressed with stones at the sacrifice, then exhilarating (the gods) with praise, sing the holy strain (aloud) like (screaming) swans, and, together with the gods, drink the sweet juice of the Soma.

Special Topics

विप्राः—मेधाविनः (*viprāḥ—medhāvinaḥ*). The word vipra is read among the names for "wise" (Ni. 3-19). It means an intelligent, discerning person. The Nirukta commentators explain: विविधानर्थानस्य प्राप्तुं धातीति विप्राः (*vividhānarthānasya prāptuṃ dhātīti viprāḥ*).

श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*)—श्लोक्यते शस्यतेऽनेनेति श्लोकः शस्त्रं (*ślokyate śasyate 'neneti ślokaḥ śastraṃ*). Because it is well recited, śloka means the recitation of a mantra. Here the meaning stated is the recitation of śastra mantras.

हंसा इव—यथा हंसाः सम्यक् शब्दं कुर्वंति तद्वत् (*haṃsā iva—yathā haṃsāḥ samyak śabdaṃ kurvaṃti tadvat*). As swans make a sweet, tinkling sound, so you priests should recite the śastra mantras with a sweet voice. Thus the example of swans is given.

Kuśikā: Yāska, giving the explanation of the word Kuśika, says:

कुशिकस्य सूनुः कुशिको राजा बभूव । क्रोशतेः शब्द कर्मणः । क्रंशतेर्वा स्यात् प्रकाशयतिकर्मणः साधुविक्रोशयितार्थानामिति वा ॥ (*kuśikasya sūnuḥ kuśiko rājā babhūva | krośateḥ śabda karmaṇaḥ | kraṃśatervā syāt prakāśayatikarmaṇaḥ sādhuvikrośayitārthānāmiti vā ‖*) (Ni. 9-25).

That is: there was a king named Kuśika. He had a son, whose name too was Kuśika. How this name came to him: because he was always saying that one should do only what is good, the name Kuśika came to him, formed from the root krośati, meaning "to sound". Or, because he made good deeds and dharmas manifest, the word Kuśika, formed from the root kraṃśati, meaning "to make manifest", became this king's name;

or, because he gave gifts to good and virtuous people, he got the name Kuśika. Thus the derivation of the word Kuśika is given.

The king named Kuśika is traditionally held to be the original ancestor of the people known as Kuśikas. Viśvāmitra too belongs to this Kuśika line. The name of these Kuśikas is prominent especially in the third maṇḍala of the Ṛgveda: the name Kuśikāḥ is read in the Ṛks Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-26-1; 3-29-15; 3-30-20; 3-33-5; 3-42-9; 3-50-4; 3-53-9, 10.[?84] Their name is also indicated in the Śunaḥśepa story in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa (Ai. Brā. 7-18; Sāṅkhyāyana Śrauta Sūtra 15-27) and in the Sāṅkhyāyana Śrauta Sūtra. These Kuśikas belonged to a family of priests; they are renowned chiefly as priests of the kings born in the Bharata clan. There are many proofs that they always praised Indra above all and took refuge in him. (Therefore in the Ṛk Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-10-11 Indra, who favours the Kuśikas, is called by the name Kauśika.) On this matter the commentator cites the account given in the Anukramaṇikā:

कुशिकसौषीरथिरिंद्रतुल्यं पुत्रमिच्छन् ब्रह्मचर्यं चचार । तस्येंद्र एव (*kuśikasauṣīrathiriṃdratulyaṃ putramicchan brahmacaryaṃ cacāra* | *tasyeṃdra eva*) (Pu. Anu. 3-1).[?85]

Skandasvāmin says on this matter:

अत्र चेतिहासमाचक्षते । इषीरथपुत्रः कुशिको नामराजा पुत्रमिंद्रतुल्यं कामयमानो ब्रह्मचर्यं चचार । तस्य गाधी नामेंद्र एव स्वयं पुत्रो जात इति ॥ (*atra cetihāsamācakṣate | iṣīrathaputraḥ kuśiko nāmarājā putramiṃdratulyaṃ kāmayamāno brahmacaryaṃ cacāra | tasya gādhī nāmeṃdra eva svayaṃ putro jāta iti ‖*).

Veṅkaṭamādhava says:

पुत्रमिंद्रसममिच्छन् कुशिको ब्रह्मचर्यं चचार । तस्येंद्रः स्वयमेव पुत्रोऽभत् । सास्य कौशिकता ॥ (*putramiṃdrasamamicchan kuśiko brahmacaryaṃ cacāra | tasyeṃdraḥ svayameva putro 'bhat | sāsya kauśikatā ‖*).

The main sense is this: formerly a king named Iṣīratha had a son named Kuśika. Desiring a son equal to Indra, he practised brahmacarya. Then Indra himself was born as his son under the name Gādhi. The seer Viśvāmitra is the son of King Gādhi and the seer of the third maṇḍala. Therefore the Kuśikas have a close relation with Viśvāmitra, and there is a reason why the Kuśikas worship Indra in particular.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उप॒ प्रेत॑ कुशिकाश्चे॒तय॑ध्व॒मश्वं॑ रा॒ये प्र मुं॑ञ्चता सु॒दा
सं॑◌ः ।
रा॒जा॑ वृ॒त्रं जं॑ङ्घ॒नत्प्रागपा॒गुद॒गथा॑ यजाते॒ वर॒ आ पृ॑
थि॒व्याः ॥ ११ ॥

> *upa preta kuśikāścetayadhvamaśvaṃ rāye pra muñcatā sudāsaḥ |*
> *rājā vṛtraṃ jaṅghanatprāgapāgudagathā yajāte vara ā pṛthivyāḥ ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उप । प्र । इत । कुशिकाः । चेतयध्वं । अश्वं । राये । प्र । मुंचत । सुदासः ।
> राजा । वृत्रं । जंघनत् । प्रात् । अपाक् । उदक् । अथ । यजाते । वरे । आ ।
> पृथिव्याः । ११ ॥

> *upa | pra | ita | kuśikāḥ | cetayadhvaṃ | aśvaṃ | rāye | pra | muṃcata | sudāsaḥ |*
> *rājā | vṛtraṃ | jaṃghanat | prāt | apāk | udak | atha | yajāte | vare | ā |*
> *pṛthivyāḥ | 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे कुशिकाः कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्ना हे पुत्रा उप प्रेत । अश्वस्य समीपे प्रकर्षण गच्छत । तत्र गत्वा चेतयध्वं । सावधाना भवत । यद्वा । आश्वरक्षिणः सावधानान् कुरुत । सुदासः पैजवनस्य राज्योऽश्वं राये तस्य दिग्विजयेन धनलाभाय
> प्र मुंचत । राजा देवानां स्वामींद्रो वृत्रं कर्मविघ्नकारिणमसुरं प्रागपागुदक् पूर्वपश्चिमोत्तरेषु देशेषु जंघनत् । भृशं हतवान् । तस्मादश्वं विमुंचतेति भावः । आधानंतरं पृथिव्या वर उत्तमे देवयजनदेशे यजाते । स राजा
> यजीत ॥ चेतयध्वं । चिती संज्ञान इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लोटि रूपं । आमंत्रितस्याविद्यमानवत्तेन तिजि उत्तरत्वान्न निघातः । जंघनत् । हन हिंसागत्योरित्यस्य यज्लुकि नुगतोऽनुनासिकांतस्येत्यभ्यासस्य नुगागमः । तदंताल्लेट्यडागमः । प्राक् ।
> अंचतेः क्विनि रूपं । अनिगंतोऽंचतावप्रत्यय इति गतेः स्वरः । यजाते । यजतेर्लेट्प्याडागमः । निघातः । वरे । वृञ् वरण इत्यस्मात् ग्रहवृदृनिश्चिगमश्चेत्यप्पत्ययः । तस्य पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he kuśikāḥ kuśikagotrotpannā he putrā upa preta | aśvasya samīpe prakarṣaṇa gacchata | tatra gatvā cetayadhvaṃ | sāvadhānā bhavata | yadvā | āśvarakṣiṇaḥ sāvadhānān kuruta | sudāsaḥ paijavanasya rājyo 'śvaṃ rāye tasya digvijayena dhanalābhāya*
> *pra muṃcata | rājā devānāṃ svāmīṃdro vṛtraṃ karmavighnakāriṇamasuraṃ prāgapāgudak pūrvapaścimottareṣu deśeṣu jaṃghanat | bhṛśaṃ hatavān | tasmādaśvaṃ vimuṃcateti bhāvaḥ | ādhānaṃtaraṃ pṛthivyā vara uttame devayajanadeśe yajāte | sa rājā*
> *yajīta ‖ cetayadhvaṃ | citī saṃjñāna ityasya ṇyaṃtasya loṭi rūpaṃ | āmaṃtritasyāvidyamānavattena tiji uttaratvānna nighātaḥ | jaṃghanat | hana hiṃsāgatyorityasya yajluki nugato 'nunāsikāṃtasyetyabhyāsasya nugāgamaḥ | tadaṃtālletyaḍāgamaḥ | prāk |*
> *aṃcateḥ kvini rūpaṃ | anigaṃto 'ṃcatāvapratyaya iti gateḥ svaraḥ | yajāte | yajaterlèṭpyāḍāgamaḥ | nighātaḥ | vare | vṛñ varaṇa ityasmāt grahavṛdṛniścigamaścetyappatyayaḥ | tasya pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Kuśikas, sons born in the Kuśika lineage, go forward to the horse", that is, approach the horse. Having gone there, "attend", that is, be watchful. Or else: make the horse-guards watchful. "Release the horse of Sudās Paijavana, the king, for wealth", that is, for gaining wealth by his conquest of the quarters. "The king", Indra, lord of the gods, has struck Vṛtra, the demon who obstructs rites, in the eastern, western and northern regions, that is, has smitten him heavily. Therefore release the horse: this is the sense. Afterwards "in the best of the earth", in the excellent place for the sacrifice to the gods, "he shall sacrifice": that king should sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- कुशिकाः (*kuśikāḥ*)—O sages born in the Kuśika line
- उप प्रेत (*upa preta*)—approach (the horse) and walk
- चेतयध्वं (*cetayadhvaṃ*)—be watchful; or make the horse-guards watchful
- राजा (*rājā*)—Indra, lord of all the gods
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—the demon Vṛtra (who causes obstacles to the sacrificial rite)
- प्राक् (*prāk*)—in the east
- अपाक् (*apāk*)—in the west
- उदक् (*udak*)—in the north
- जंघनत् (*jaṃghanat*)—has destroyed (therefore)
- सुदासः (*sudāsaḥ*)—of the king named Sudās
- अश्वं (*aśvaṃ*)—the horse
- राये (*rāye*)—for the gaining of wealth
- प्र मुंचत (*pra muṃcata*)—loosen and release
- अथ (*atha*)—afterwards
- पृथिव्याः (*pṛthivyāḥ*)—of the earth
- वरे (*vare*)—in an excellent region
- यजाते (*yajāte*)—perform the sacrifice (fearlessly)

Gist

O sages of the Kuśika line, go to the horse and make the horse-guards watchful. Indra, lord of all the gods, has destroyed the demon Vṛtra, who obstructs the sacrificial rite, in all directions beginning with the east. Therefore, without the least fear, release the horse of King Sudās for the gaining of wealth. Afterwards perform the sacrifice fearlessly in an excellent region of the earth.

English translation

Approach, Kushikas, the steed of Sudas ; animate (him), and let him loose to (win) riches (for the raja); for the king (of the gods) has slain Vritra in the East, in the West, in the North, therefore let (Sudas) worship him in the best (regions) of the earth.

Special Topics

This Ṛk describes how King Sudās performed the Aśvamedha sacrifice with the help of Viśvāmitra.

कुशिकाः उप प्र इत चेतयद्वं (*kuśikāḥ upa pra ita cetayadvaṃ*)—कुशिकगोत्रोत्पन्ना पुत्रा अश्वस्य समीपे गच्छत। गत्वा च सावधाना भवत। अश्वरक्षिणः सावधानान् कुरुतः (*kuśikagotrotpannā putrā aśvasya samīpe gacchata| gatvā ca sāvadhānā bhavata| aśvarakṣiṇaḥ sāvadhānān kurutaḥ*). The seer Viśvāmitra addresses his sons and kinsmen born in the Kuśika line, speaking thus: O sons and others of the Kuśika line, hear what I say. In this Aśvamedha sacrifice that King Sudās is performing, go near the sacrificial horse, remain there attentively, and help to guard it.

सुदासः अश्वं राये प्र मुंचत (*sudāsaḥ aśvaṃ rāye pra muṃcata*)—In the sacrifice (or the expedition of conquest) of Sudās, undertaken for the gain of wealth, release the sacrificial horse to wander.[?86] Here an explanation of "release the sacrificial horse to wander" is necessary. The sacrifice called Aśvamedha is one that only kings of the kṣatriya class perform. Much wealth is needed to perform this sacrifice. Therefore the king who sacrifices takes the initiation for the sacrifice, honours the sacrificial horse with the prescribed worship and the rest,

and lets it wander freely for a period of one year. Following the horse, the king's men set out with an army, conquer the kings of whatever countries the horse goes to, collect tribute from them, and after one year return and join their own country. Until then the king keeps to observances such as brahmacarya, and after the horse has come back he performs the sacrifice: this is the custom. This very matter is indicated here by the sentence "release the horse for wealth", that is, release the horse for earning wealth. It is also a description of the conquest of the quarters undertaken for the gaining of wealth by the king named Sudās, son of Pijavana.[?87] The meaning of the latter half of this Ṛk is clear.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

य इ॒मे रोद॑सी उ॒भे अ॒हमिन्द्र॒मतु॑ष्टवम् ।
वि॒श्वामि॑त्रस्य रक्षति॒ ब्रह्मे॒दं भार॑तं॒ जन॑म् ॥ १२ ॥

> *ya ime rodasī ubhe ahamindramatuṣṭavam |*
> *viśvāmitrasya rakṣati brahmedaṃ bhārataṃ janam ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । इमे इति । रोदसी इति । उभे इति । अहं । इंद्रं । अतुस्तवं ।
> विश्वामित्रस्य । रक्षति । ब्रह्म । इदं । भारतं । जनं ॥ १२ ॥

> *yaḥ | ime iti | rodasī iti | ubhe iti | ahaṃ | iṃdraṃ | atustavaṃ |*
> *viśvāmitrasya | rakṣati | brahma | idaṃ | bhārataṃ | janaṃ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे कुशिकाः कुशिकपुत्रा योऽहं विश्वामित्र उभे इमे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्याविंद्रमतुष्टवं स्तावयामि । द्यावापृथिवीभ्यामिंद्रस्य स्तोत्रं मया कारितमित्यर्थः । यद्वा । उभयो रोदस्कोरंतरवस्थितमिंद्रं स्तौमि । स्तोत्रं कुर्वाणस्य विश्वामित्रस्य ममेदमिंद्रविषयं ब्रह्म स्तोत्रं भारतं भरतकुलं जनं रक्षति ।
> पालयति ॥ अतुष्टवं । ष्टुञ् स्तुत् । ण्यंतस्य लुजं चजं रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । भारतं । भरतशब्द उत्सादिः । इांत्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he kuśikāḥ kuśikaputrā yo 'haṃ viśvāmitra ubhe ime rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyāviṃdramatuṣṭavaṃ stāvayāmi | dyāvāpṛthivībhyāmiṃdrasya stotraṃ mayā kāritamityarthaḥ | yadvā | ubhayo rodaskoraṃtaravasthitamiṃdraṃ staumi | stotraṃ kurvāṇasya viśvāmitrasya mamedamiṃdraviṣayaṃ brahma stotraṃ bhārataṃ bharatakulaṃ janaṃ rakṣati |*

> *pālayati ‖ atuṣṭavaṃ | ṣṭuñ stut | ṇyaṃtasya lujaṃ cajaṃ rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | bhārataṃ | bharataśabda utsādiḥ | iāṃtvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Kuśikas, sons of Kuśika: I, Viśvāmitra, "have praised Indra" through "these two, heaven and earth", that is, I have caused praise: the praise of Indra has been made by me through heaven and earth. Or else: I praise Indra, who stands between the two worlds. This hymn of mine, of Viśvāmitra who is offering praise, concerning Indra, protects, guards, the people of the Bharata family.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः अहं (*yaḥ ahaṃ*)—I, who am renowned as Viśvāmitra
- उभे इमे रोदसी (*ubhe ime rodasī*)—pervading between these two, heaven and earth
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- अतुष्टवं (*atuṣṭavaṃ*)—I praise
- विश्वामित्रस्य (*viśvāmitrasya*)—of me, such a praiser
- इदं ब्रह्म (*idaṃ brahma*)—this praise concerning Indra
- भारतं जनं (*bhārataṃ janaṃ*)—all the people of the Bharata family
- रक्षति (*rakṣati*)—protects

Gist

I, who am renowned as Viśvāmitra, praise Indra, who pervades between these two, heaven and earth. This praise of Indra, by me who offer such praise, protects all the people of the Bharata family.

English translation

I have made Indra glorified by these two, heaven and earth, and this prayer of Vishwamitra protects the race of Bharata.

Special Topics

भारतं जनं (*bhāratam janaṃ*)—The people called Bharata were a very important people in the Ṛgveda period. From many Ṛks it is known that Viśvāmitra too was born in this people. In the Ṛks Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33-11 and 12, when the seer Viśvāmitra praises the rivers Pipāṭ and Śutudrī,[?88] in the Ṛks

यदंग त्वा भरताः संतरेयुर्गव्यन्ग्राम इषित इंद्रजूतः । (*yadaṃga tvā bharatāḥ saṃtareyurgavyangrāma iṣita iṃdrajūtaḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3.33-1)[?89]

अतारिषुर्भरता गव्यवः समभक्त विप्रः सुमतिं नदीनां । (*atāriṣurbharatā gavyavaḥ samabhakta vipraḥ sumatiṃ nadīnāṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-33-12)

he prays that the rivers should lessen their water so that his own people, the Bharata people, may be able to cross those rivers. Just as the seer Viśvāmitra is related to the Bharata people, the name of the seer Vasiṣṭha[?90] is also seen mentioned here and there along with theirs. The original ancestor of this Bharata people was Bharata himself. It is said in other Vedas too that he was a very renowned king:

महते क्षत्राय महत अभसत्याय महते जानराज्यैषवो भरता राजा । (*mahate kṣatrāya mahata abhasatyāya mahate jānarājyaiṣavo bharatā rājā* |) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-8-10-2)

as is said in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā. This Bharata's name is also indicated in the Śunaḥśepa story in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa. The matter of this Bharata and the Bharata people will be explained in detail later.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि॒श्वामि॑त्रा अरासत॒ ब्रह्मेन्द्रा॑य व॒ज्रिणे॑ ।
क॒रदि॑न्नः सु॒राध॑सः ॥ १३ ॥

> *viśvāmitrā arāsata brahmendrāya vajriṇe |*
> *karadinnaḥ surādhasaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विश्वामित्राः । अरासत । ब्रह्म । इंद्राय । वज्रिणे ।
> करत् । इत् । नः । सुराधसः ॥ १३ ॥

> *viśvāmitrāḥ | arāsata | brahma | iṃdrāya | vajriṇe |*
> *karat | it | naḥ | surādhasaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वामित्रा वज्रिणे वज्रहस्तायेंद्राय ब्रह्म स्तोत्रमरासत । अकुर्वन् ।
> स्तुतः स इंद्रो नोऽस्मान् सुराधसः शोभनधनोपेतान् करदित् । करोत्वेव ॥
> अरासत । रास्प शब्द इत्यस्य लजि बहुलं छंदसीति शपो लुक् । निघातः । करत् ।
> करोतेर्लुजि चेः कृमृद्यरुहिभ्यश्चंदसीत्यजादेशः । सुराधसः । आद्युदात्तं
> द्व्यंचदसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *viśvāmitrā vajriṇe vajrahastāyeṃdrāya brahma stotramarāsata | akurvan |*
> *stutaḥ sa iṃdro no 'smān surādhasaḥ śobhanadhanopetān karadit | karotveva ‖*
> *arāsata | rāspa śabda ityasya laji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapo luk | nighātaḥ | karat |*
> *karoterluji ceḥ kṛmṛdyaruhibhyaścaṃdasītyajādeśaḥ | surādhasaḥ | ādyudāttaṃ*
> *dvyaṃcadasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The Viśvāmitras made a hymn (brahma, praise) for Indra, the vajra-holder, the one who has the thunderbolt in his hand. Being praised, may that Indra make us "possessed of fair wealth", that is, endowed with good riches: करदित् (*karadit*), let him indeed do it.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वामित्राः (*viśvāmitrāḥ*)—the kinsmen of Viśvāmitra
- वज्रिणे (*vajriṇe*)—who holds the thunderbolt weapon
- इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)—addressed to Indra
- ब्रह्म (*brahma*)—the praise
- अरासत (*arāsata*)—have composed (Indra, thus praised)
- नः (*naḥ*)—us

- सुराधसः (*surādhasaḥ*)—as possessors of excellent wealth
- करदित् (*karadit*)—let him certainly make

Gist

The kinsmen of Viśvāmitra have composed praise addressed to Indra, who holds the thunderbolt weapon. May Indra, thus praised, make us possessors of excellent wealth.

English translation

The Vishwamitras have addressd the prayer to Indra, the wielder of the thunderbolt ; may he therefore render us very opulent.

Special Topics

विश्वामित्राः (*viśvāmitrāḥ*)—Here the plural form Viśvāmitrāḥ is used to indicate Viśvāmitra and his sons, other relatives, those born in the Kuśika line, and others.

अरासत (*arāsata*)—स्तोत्रमकुर्वन् (*stotramakurvan*). The word अरासत (*arāsata*) is formed from the root रासृ (*rāsṛ*) (रासृ शब्दे (*rāsṛ śabde*)), meaning "to make a sound". It means "they made a sound", that is, they recited praise.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

किं ते॑ कृण्वन्ति॒ कीक॑टेषु॒ गावो॒ नाशिरं॑ दु॒ह्रे न त॑पन्ति घ॒र्मम् ।
आ नो॑ भर॒ प्रम॑गन्दस्य॒ वेदो॑ नैचाशा॒खं म॑घवन्रन्धया नः ॥ १४ ॥

> *kiṃ te kṛṇvanti kīkaṭeṣu gāvo nāśiraṃ duhre na tapanti gharmam |*
> *ā no bhara pramagandasya vedo naicāśākhaṃ maghavanrandhayā naḥ ||*
> *14 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> कं । ते । कृण्वंति । कीकटेषु । गावः । न । आशिरम् । दुह्रे । न । तपंति । घर्म० ।
> आ । नः । भर । प्रमगंदस्य । वेदः । नैचाशाखं । मघवन् । रंधये । नः ॥ १४ '

> *kaṃ | te | kṛṇvaṃti | kīkaṭeṣu | gāvaḥ | na | āśiram | duhre | na | tapaṃti | gharmao |*
> *ā | naḥ | bhara | pramagaṃdasya | vedaḥ | naicāśākhaṃ | maghavan | raṃdhaye | naḥ ‖ 14 '*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र कीकटेः स्वनार्यनिवासेषु जनपदेषु । यद्वा । क्रियाभिर्यागदानहोमलक्षणाभिः किं फलिष्यतीत्यश्रद्दधानाः प्रत्युत पिबत खादतायमेव लोको न
> पर इति वदंतो नास्तिका कीयटाः । तेषु गावस्ते तव किं कृण्वंति । किं कुर्वंति ।
> न क्वचित्तवोपयोगं कुर्वंतीत्यर्थः । अनुपयोगं दर्शयति आशिरं सोममिश्रणयोग्यं पयो न दुह्रे । न दुहंति । किंच घर्मं प्रवर्ग्याख्यकर्मोपयुक्तं
> महावीरपात्रं स्वपयःप्रदानद्वारेण न तपंति । न दीपयंति । एतेन णांनाय्याद्यर्थमपि नोपयुज्यंत इत्यपि सूचितं भवति । एवं क्वचिदसि नैरिके कर्मण्णनप
> युक्तास्ता गा नोऽस्मभ्यमा भर । अहर । न केवलं ता एव किं तर्हि प्रमगंदस ।
> द्वैगुणादिलक्षणपरिमाणं गतोऽर्थो मामेव गमिष्यतीति बुद्ध्या परेषां ददातीति मगंदो वार्धुषिकः । तस्यापत्यं पुत्रादिः प्रमगंद प्रस्कण्वादिवदपत्यार्थ,
> प्रशब्देन द्योत्यते । तस्यात्यंतकुसीदिकुलस्य वेदो धनमाहर । किंच हे मघव
> न्नवन्निंद्र नैचाशाखं । नीचासु शूद्रयोनिषूत्पादिता शाखा पुत्रपौत्रादिपरंपरा
> येन स नीचाराखः । शूद्रापत्यैश्च केवलैः शूद्रवेदी पतत्त्वथ इति च पातकहेतुतेन स्मरणात् । पतितस्य संबंधि धनं नैचाशाख. । तद्वनु नोऽस्मभ्यं रुधय

> *he iṃdra kīkaṭèḥ svanāryanivāseṣu janapadeṣu | yadvā | kriyābhiryāgadānahomalakṣaṇābhiḥ kiṃ phaliṣyatītyaśraddhadhānāḥ pratyuta pibata khādatāyameva loko na*
> *para iti vadaṃto nāstikā kīyaṭāḥ | teṣu gāvaste tava kiṃ kṛṇvaṃti | kiṃ kurvaṃti |*
> *na kvacittavopayogaṃ kurvaṃtītyarthaḥ | anupayogaṃ darśayati āśiraṃ somamiśraṇayogyaṃ payo na duhre | na duhaṃti | kiṃca gharmaṃ pravargyākhyakarmopayuktaṃ*
> *mahāvīrapātraṃ svapayaḥpradānadvāreṇa na tapaṃti | na dīpayaṃti | etena ṇāṃnāyyādyarthamapi nopayujyaṃta ityapi sūcitaṃ bhavati | evaṃ kvacidasi nairike karmaṇṇanapa*
> *yuktāstā gā no 'smabhyamā bhara | ahara | na kevalaṃ tā eva kiṃ tarhi*

> *pramagaṃdasa |*
> *dvaiguṇādilakṣaṇaparimāṇaṃ gato 'rtho māmeva gamiṣyatīti buddhyā*
> *pareṣāṃ dadātīti magaṃdo vārdhuṣikaḥ | tasyāpatyaṃ putrādiḥ*
> *pramagaṃda praskaṇvādivadapatyārtha,*
> *praśabdena dyotyate | tasyātyaṃtakusīdikulasya vedo dhanamāhara |*
> *kiṃca he maghava*
> *nnavanniṃdra naicāśākhaṃ | nīcāsu śūdrayoniṣūtpāditā śākhā*
> *putrapautrādiparaṃparā*
> *yena sa nīcārākhaḥ | śūdrāpatyaiśca kevalaiḥ śūdravedī patattvatha iti*
> *ca pātakahetutena smaraṇāt | patitasya saṃbaṃdhi dhanaṃ*
> *naicāśākha. | tadvanu no 'smabhyaṃ rudhaya*

> साधय । एतेषां तद्धनं तव नोपयुज्यते अस्मदायत्तं तु तद्धनं यागादिद्वारा
> तवोऽपयुज्यते । तस्मात्तदस्मभ्यं प्रयच्छेति भावः ॥ एतमर्थं यास्कोऽपाह । किं
> ते कुर्वंति कीकटेषु गावः । कीकटो नाम देशोऽनार्यनिवासः । कीकटाः
> किंकृताः किं क्रियाभिरितिप्रेप्सा वा । नैव चाशिरं दुह्रे न तपंति घर्मं घरणं ।
> आ हर नः प्रमगंदस्य धनानि । मगंदः कुसीदी मांगदो मामागमिष्यतीति च
> ददाति । तदसत्यं प्रमगंदोऽत्यंतकुसीदिकुलीनः । प्रमदको वा योऽयमेवास्ति
> लोको न पर इति प्रेप्पुः । पंडको वा पंडकः पंडगः प्रार्दको वा प्रार्दयत्यांडौ । आंडावाणी इव
> व्रीडयति । तत्स्थं नैचाशाखं। नीचाशाखो नीचैः
> शाखः । शाखाः शक्नोतेः । आणिररणात्। तन्नो मघवन्रंधयेति रध्यतिर्वशगमने ।
> नि. ६–३२ । इति ॥ आशिरं । आजूपूर्वाच्छ्रीणातेः क्विप्यपस्पृधेथामित्यादिना
> शिरित्यादेशः। दुह्रे। दुहेर्लिटीरयोर इति रेआदेशः । द्विर्वचनस्यविकल्पितत्वात् द्विर्वचनाभावः
> । चादिलोपे विभाषेति न निघातः । नैचाशाखं । तस्येदमित्यण् । प्रत्ययस्वरः।
> रंधय । रधेर्ण्यंतस्य रधिजभोरचीति नुमागमः ॥

> *sādhaya | eteṣāṃ taddhanaṃ tava nopayujyate asmadāyattaṃ tu*
> *taddhanaṃ yāgādidvārā*
> *tavo 'payujyate | tasmāttadasmabhyaṃ prayaccheti bhāvaḥ ‖*
> *etamarthaṃ yāsko 'pāha | kiṃ*
> *te kurvaṃti kīkaṭeṣu gāvaḥ | kīkaṭo nāma deśo 'nāryanivāsaḥ | kīkaṭāḥ*
> *kiṃkṛtāḥ kiṃ kriyābhiritiprepsā vā | naiva cāśiraṃ duhre na tapaṃti*
> *gharmaṃ gharaṇaṃ |*
> *ā hara naḥ pramagaṃdasya dhanāni | magaṃdaḥ kusīdī māṃgado*
> *māmāgamiṣyatīti ca*
> *dadāti | tadasatyaṃ pramagaṃdo 'tyaṃtakusīdikulīnaḥ | pramadako vā*
> *yo 'yamevāsti*

> *loko na para iti preppuḥ | paṃḍako vā paṃḍakaḥ paṃḍagaḥ prārdako vā prārdayatyāṃḍau | āṃḍāvāṇī iva vrīḍayati | tatsthaṃ naicāśākhaṃ| nīcāśākho nīcaiḥ*
>
> *śākhaḥ | śākhāḥ śaknoteḥ | āṇiraraṇāt| tanno maghavanraṃdhayeti radhyatirvaśagamane |*
>
> *ni. 6-32 | iti ‖ āśiraṃ | ājpūrvāccīṇāteḥ kvipyapaspṛdhethāmityādinā śirityādeśaḥ| duhre| duherliṭīrayora iti reādeśaḥ | dvirvacanasyavikalpitatvāt dvirvacanābhāvaḥ | cādilope vibhāṣeti na nighātaḥ | naicāśākhaṃ | tasyedamityaṇ | pratyayasvaraḥ| raṃdhaya | radherṇyaṃtasya radhijabhoracīti numāgamaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Indra, what do the cattle do for you among the Kīkaṭas?" Kīkaṭas are the countries that are dwellings of non-Āryas; or else, the unbelieving nāstikas who, doubting what any rite of sacrifice, gift and oblation will yield, say "drink, eat, only this world exists, there is no other". What do the cattle among them do for you? They are of no use to you. He shows their uselessness: they do not milk the आशिरं (*āśiraṃ*), the milk fit for mixing with Soma. Further, the Mahāvīra vessel used in the rite called Pravargya, the घर्मं (*gharmaṃ*), they do not heat, they do not make it glow by giving it their milk. By this it is also suggested that they are not used even for the Sāṃnāyya and the like. Thus they are useless in any rite; "bring those cattle to us". Not only these: also the wealth of Pramagaṇḍa. A मगंद (*magaṃda*) is a usurer, who lends to others with the thought "the wealth, once it has grown to double and so on, will come back to me alone". His offspring, a son and the like, is Pramagaṇḍa; the sense of offspring is conveyed by the prefix प्र (*pra*), as in Praskaṇva and others. "Bring the wealth of that family of extreme usurers." Further, "O Maghavan, Indra, नैचाशाखं (*naicāśākhaṃ*)": he by whom a branch, a line of sons and grandsons, has been produced in low (women), in śūdra wombs, is नीचाशाख (*nīcāśākha*); for by the smṛti, one who marries a śūdra woman, and one who is a śūdra-husband with children only by śūdra women, falls, being a cause of sin. The wealth connected with such a fallen man is नैचाशाखं (*naicāśākhaṃ*); "accomplish that for us" (the text continues on the next page).

"Accomplish it": their wealth is of no use to you, but our wealth, depending on us, is of use to you through sacrifices and the like; therefore give it to us, is the sense. Yāska says on this meaning: "What do the cattle do for you among the Kīkaṭas? Kīkaṭa is the name of a country, the dwelling of non-Āryas. Or the Kīkaṭas are किंकृताः (*kiṃkṛtāḥ*), those who ask 'what by rites?'. They do not milk the āśira, they do not heat the gharma. Bring us the wealth of Pramagaṇḍa. A मगंद (*magaṃda*) is a usurer: 'it will come to me', so he gives. That is untrue: Pramagaṇḍa is one born in an extremely usurious family; or प्रमदक (*pramadaka*), one who desires 'only this world exists, no other'; or पंडक (*paṃḍaka*), पंडग (*paṃḍaga*), or प्रार्दक (*prārdaka*), who ... ; नैचाशाखं (*naicāśākhaṃ*): नीचाशाख (*nīcāśākha*) is नीचैः शाखः (*nīcaiḥ śākhaḥ*) ... 'that, Maghavan, accomplish for us'; the root रध्यति (*radhyati*) is in the sense of coming into one's power" (Ni. 6-32).[?91]. The remainder of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- कीकटेषु (*kīkaṭeṣu*)—among the community of unbelieving Kīkaṭas
- गावः (*gāvaḥ*)—cattle
- ते (*te*)—to you
- किं कृण्वंति (*kiṃ kṛṇvaṃti*)—what use do they produce
- आशिरं (*āśiraṃ*)—the milk fit for mixing with Soma
- न दुह्रे (*na duhre*)—they do not yield
- घर्मं (*gharmaṃ*)—the Mahāvīra vessel used in the Pravargya sacrifice
- न तपंति (*na tapaṃti*)—they do not make it glow (therefore)
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us who serve you in the sacrifice
- आ भर (*ā bhara*)—bring (those cattle)
- प्रमगंदस्य (*pramagaṃdasya*)—of the line of Pramagaṇḍa, of ill family
- वेदः (*vedaḥ*)—the wealth (bring to us)
- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- नैचाशाखं (*naicāśākhaṃ*)—the wealth of those born in low lineage
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us

- रंधय (*raṃdhaya*)—accomplish

Gist

O Indra, possessor of wealth, the cattle in the community of the unbelieving Kīkaṭas are not useful for your sacrifice; their milk is not used for mixing with Soma, and their milk does not make the Mahāvīra vessel of the Pravargya glow. Therefore bring those cattle to us, who serve you in sacrificing. Accomplish for us also the wealth of the line of the ill-born Pramagaṇḍa and of the other low branches.

English translation

What do the cattle for you among the Kikasas ; they yield no milk to mix with the Soma, they need not the vessel (for the libation) : bring them to us : (bring also) the wealth of the son of the usurer, and give us, Maghavan, (the possessions) of the low branches (of the community).

Special Topics

कीकटेषु गावः ते किं कृण्वंति (*kīkaṭeṣu gāvaḥ te kiṃ kṛṇvaṃti*)—O Indra, the cattle among wicked people, non-Āryas and unbelievers, do no useful work for you; since wicked non-Āryas do not perform sacrifices and the like for Indra, the cattle among them and their milk are wasted, not used for sacrifices. So how could those cattle be of use to you, Indra? They are not, is the sense.

कीकटेषु (*kīkaṭeṣu*)—आनार्यनिवासेषु जनपदेषु । यद्वा । क्रियाभिर्यागदानहोमलक्षणाभिः किंफलिष्यतीत्यश्रद्दधानाः प्रत्युत पिबत खादतायमेव लोको न पर इति वदंतो नास्तिकाः कीकटाः तेषु। (*ānāryanivāseṣu janapadeṣu | yadvā | kriyābhiryāgadānahomalakṣaṇābhiḥ kiṃphaliṣyatītyaśraddadhānāḥ pratyuta pibata khādatāyameva loko na para iti vadaṃto nāstikāḥ kīkaṭāḥ teṣu*|) Kīkaṭas are the uncivilized earlier inhabitants of this country, not of the Ārya lineage, who do not perform sacrifices like Āryas, do not worship Indra and the other gods, and trouble the Āryas and their sacrifices. Or, though born in the Ārya line, they perform no good deeds such as sacrifice, gift and homa, and without faith in them say "what use are they? there is no world but this; no heaven, hell, sin or merit; all that is imagination; so eat and drink what you want to be happy": such wicked unbelievers. Thus the meaning has been explained.

आशिरं न दुह्रे न तपंति घर्मं (*āśiraṃ na duhre na tapaṃti gharmaṃ*)—सोममिश्रणयोग्यं पयः न दुहंति । किंच प्रवर्ग्यकर्मोपयुक्तं महावीरपात्रं स्वपयःप्रदानद्वारेण न दीपयंति । एतेन सांनाय्यार्थमपि नोपयुज्यंत इत्यपि सूचितं भवति । (*somamiśraṇayogyaṃ payaḥ na duhaṃti | kiṃca pravargyakarmopayuktaṃ mahāvīrapātraṃ svapayaḥpradānadvāreṇa na dīpayaṃti | etena sāṃnāyyārthamapi nopayujyaṃta ityapi sūcitaṃ bhavati* |) The milk that cattle among non-Āryas yield serves no good rite; they do not give milk for mixing with the Soma juice, that is, their milk is not useful for Soma mixed with the milk called gavāśira. Moreover, their milk cannot be used for the milk placed in the Mahāvīra vessel in the Pravargya sacrifice, nor for the Sāṃnāyya.

नः आ भर (*naḥ ā bhara*)—Therefore Indra is prayed: bring to us the cattle that are among those wicked people.

प्रमगंदस्य वेदः (*pramagaṃdasya vedaḥ*)—द्वैगुण्यादिलक्षणपरिमाणं गतोऽर्थो मामेव गमिष्यतीति बुद्धा परेषां ददातीति मगंदो वार्धुषिकः। तस्यापत्यं पुत्रादिः प्रमगंदः । प्रस्कण्वादिवदपत्यार्थः प्रशब्देन द्योत्यते । तस्यात्यंतकुसीदकुलस्य वेदः धनमाहर । (*dvaiguṇyādilakṣaṇaparimāṇaṃ gato 'rtho māmeva gamiṣyatīti buddhā pareṣāṃ dadātīti magaṃdo vārdhuṣikaḥ| tasyāpatyaṃ putrādiḥ pramagaṃdaḥ | praskaṇvādivadapatyārthaḥ praśabdena dyotyate | tasyātyaṃtakusīdakulasya vedaḥ dhanamāhara* |) One who lends money to others with the evil thought that, lent to someone, it will come back with interest at double the sum, is called मगंद (*magaṃda*). His son is प्रमगंद (*pramagaṃda*). As the son of the sage Kaṇva is called Praskaṇva, the prefix प्र (*pra*) indicates the sense of son (apatya); so when the prefix प्र (*pra*) is joined to मगंद (*magaṃda*), Pramagaṇḍa means the son of Magaṇḍa. Indra is prayed to bring to us the unjustly acquired wealth of such a Pramagaṇḍa.

नैचाशाखं (*naicāśākhaṃ*)—नीचासु शूद्रयोनिषु उत्पादिता शाखा पुत्रपौत्रादिपरंपरा येन स नीचाशाखः । पतितस्य संबंधि धनं नैचशाखं । तद्धनं नः साधय । एतेषां तद्धनं तव नोपयुज्यते अस्मादायत्तं तु तद्धनं यागादिद्वारा तवोपयुज्यते । तस्मात्तदस्मभ्यं प्रयच्छेति भावः । (*nīcāsu* *śūdrayoniṣu utpāditā śākhā putrapautrādiparaṃparā yena sa nīcāśākhaḥ | patitasya saṃbaṃdhi dhanaṃ naicaśākhaṃ | taddhanaṃ naḥ sādhaya | eteṣāṃ taddhanaṃ tava nopayujyate asmādāyattaṃ tu taddhanaṃ yāgādidvārā tavopayujyate | tasmāttadasmabhyaṃ prayaccheti bhāvaḥ* |) The line of sons, grandsons and so on begotten by a Brāhmaṇa or others in low śūdra women is called "low branch". Since they are unfit for upanayana, Vedic study, sacrifice, gifts and other good rites and do not perform them, they are called fallen. Indra is prayed to bring to us also the wealth of such low-branch people, the fallen. For the non-Āryas, Pramagaṇḍas and fallen low-branch people mentioned before do not sacrifice or worship Indra and the other gods, so their cattle and wealth are not offered to Indra and are wasted; but if Indra brings that wealth to us, we shall use the milk of those cattle and their wealth for performing sacrifices and worshipping Indra, so the wealth will become as if useful to Indra. Hence the prayer "bring them to us" is uttered.

Yāska has given this explanation of the Mantra:

किं ते कृण्वंति कीकटेषु गावो नाशिरं दुह्रे न तपंति घर्म० ॥ (*kiṃ te kṛṇvaṃti kīkaṭeṣu gāvo nāśiraṃ duhre na tapaṃti gharmao ‖*)

आ नो भर प्रमगंदस्य वेदो नैचाशाखं मघवन्बंधया नः ॥ (*ā no bhara pramagaṃdasya vedo naicāśākhaṃ maghavanbaṃdhayā naḥ ‖*)

Its explanation is:

किं ते कुर्वंति कीकटेषु गावः । कीकटा नाम देशोऽनार्यनिवासः । कीकटाः किंकृताः किं क्रियाभिरिति प्रेप्सा वा । नैव चाशिरं दुह्रे न तपंति घर्म० हर्म्यमा हर नः प्रमगंदस्य धनानि । मगंदः कुसीदी । मांगदो मामागमिष्यतीति च ददाति तदपत्यं प्रमगंदोऽत्यंतकुसीदिकुलीनः । प्रमदको वा योऽयमेवास्ति लोको न पर इति प्रेप्सुः । पंडको वा । पंडकः पंडगः प्रार्दको वा प्रार्दयत्यांडावांडावाणी इव व्रीडयति तस्तंभे । नैचाशाखं नीचाशाखो नीचैः शाखः । शाखाः शक्नोतेः । आणिररणात् । तन्नो मघवन्नंधयेति रध्यतिर्वशगमने ॥ (*kiṃ te kurvaṃti kīkaṭeṣu gāvaḥ | kīkaṭā nāma deśo 'nāryanivāsaḥ | kīkaṭāḥ kiṃkṛtāḥ kiṃ kriyābhiriti prepsā vā | naiva cāśiraṃ duhre na tapaṃti gharmao harmyamā hara naḥ pramagaṃdasya dhanāni | magaṃdaḥ kusīdī | māṃgado māmāgamiṣyatīti ca dadāti tadapatyaṃ pramagaṃdo 'tyaṃtakusīdikulīnaḥ | pramadako vā yo 'yamevāsti loko na para iti prepsuḥ | paṃḍako vā | paṃḍakaḥ paṃḍagaḥ* *prārdako vā prārdayatyāṃḍāvāṃḍāvāṇī iva vrīḍayati tastaṃbhe | naicāśākhaṃ nīcāśākho nīcaiḥ śākhaḥ | śākhāḥ śakkoteḥ | āṇiraraṇāt | tanno maghavanraṃdhayeti radhyatirvaśagamane ||*) (Ni. 6-32)

That is: the word Kīkaṭa is the name of the country where the non-Ārya earlier inhabitants of this land live. How did these non-Ārya dwellers get the name? "Or किं कृताः (*kiṃ kṛtāḥ*), किं क्रियाभिरिति प्रेप्सा वा (*kiṃ kriyābhiriti prepsā vā*)": unbelievers who, neglecting good rites, speak with contempt, "what use are sacrifices and rites?", got the name Kiṅkṛtāḥ, or Kīkaṭāḥ. The milk of cattle among them is not rightly used, because, since they do not sacrifice, their cattle's milk is not of use for sacrifices; it is of no use as the āśira substance to be added to Soma juice; nor are the products made by heating the milk, curd, ghee and the like, fit for sacrifice. Therefore bring to us the cattle among these uncivilized people. If we get those cattle, we shall sacrifice and offer their milk, curd, ghee and so on to Indra and the other gods. Therefore Indra is prayed to give us their cattle and wealth. Further, मगंदः (*magaṃdaḥ*) means कुसीदी (*kusīdī*), a merchant whose occupation is lending goods to others and after some time taking back the money with its interest. As the prefix प्र (*pra*) is joined to मगंद (*magaṃda*), प्रमगंद (*pramagaṃda*) means a Magaṇḍa or one of the usurer family; or the prefix प्र (*pra*) in the sense of excess means one born in an exceedingly bad family. Since he gains money unjustly by taking interest at one-for-two, bring us his wealth also. Or प्रमगंद (*pramagaṃda*) may mean प्रमदक (*pramadaka*): one who says, "there is only this visible world, no heaven or other worlds; so merit and sin mean nothing; to be happy now is all; why suffer? it is good to eat, drink and live at ease; hard sacrifices are of no use" (continuing).

—such an unbeliever. Or प्रमगंद (*pramagaṃda*) may mean पंडकः (*paṃḍakaḥ*), पंडगः (*paṃḍagaḥ*) or प्रार्दक (*prārdaka*). पंडक (*paṃḍaka*) or पंडग (*paṃḍaga*) is a eunuch, one who is helpless like women. प्रार्दक (*prārdaka*) is one who behaves like women in dealings and the like, effeminate, shameless. Indra is prayed to bring the wealth of such persons also to us. And those born of upper-class parents among śūdra and other low castes are called low-branch people; since they are fallen and excluded from sacrifices and rites, their wealth is of no use for good rites. Therefore नैचाशाखं धनं (*naicāśākhaṃ dhanaṃ*): prayer is made that the wealth among such low-class people be brought to us. Here, since the root रध्यति (*radhyati*) has the sense "bring into one's power", the words मघवन् रंधय (*maghavan raṃdhaya*) in this Ṛk mean: O Indra, make (the wealth of the people mentioned above) come into our power.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒स॒र्प॒रीरम॑ति॒ं बाध॑माना बृ॒हन्मि॑माय ज॒मद॑ग्निदत्ता ।
आ सूर्य॑स्य दुहि॒ता त॑तान॒ श्रवो॑ दे॒वेष्व॒मृत॑मजु॒र्यम्
॥ १५ ॥

> *sasarparīramatiṃ bādhamānā bṛhanmimāya jamadagnidattā |*
> *ā sūryasya duhitā tatāna śravo deveṣvamṛtamajuryam ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ससर्परीः । अमतिं । बाधमाना । बृहत् । मिमाय । जमदग्निदत्ता ।
> आ । सूर्यस्य । दुहिता । ततान । श्रवः । देवेषु । अमृतं । अजुर्यं ॥ १५ ॥

> *sasarparīḥ | amatiṃ | bādhamānā | bṛhat | mimāya | jamadagnidattā |*
> *ā | sūryasya | duhitā | tatāna | śravaḥ | deveṣu | amṛtaṃ | ajuryaṃ ‖*
> *15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ससर्परीद्वृचे प्राहुरितिहासं पुराविदः । सौदासनृपयज्ञे वै वसिष्ठात्मजशक्तिना ।
> विश्वामित्रस्याभिभूतं बलं वाक् च समंततः । वासिष्ठेनाभिभूतः स ह्यवासीदथ गाधिजः ।
> तस्मै ब्राह्मीं तु सौरीं ना नाम्ना वाचं ससर्परीं । सूर्यवेश्मन
> आहृत्य ददुर्वै जमदग्नयः । कुशिकानां मतिः सा वागमतिं तामपानुदत् ॥
> जमदग्निदत्ता जमदग्निभिः प्रज्वलिताग्निभिर्यषिभिरस्मभ्यं दत्तामतिमज्ञानं
> बाधमाना ससर्परीः सर्वत्र शब्दरूपतया सर्पणशीला वाक् बृहत्प्रभूतं यथा

> भवति तथा मिमाय । नभसि शब्दं करोति । सैषा सूर्यस्य दुहिता वाग्देवता देवेष्विंद्रादिष्वजुर्यं क्षयरहितममृतममृतलक्षणं श्रवोऽन्नमा ततान । समंतात्स्वाहाकारवाचं तनोति ॥ जमदग्निदत्ता! दाण् दान इत्यस्यनिष्ठायां दो दद्वो–

> *sasarparīdvṛce prāhuritihāsaṃ purāvidaḥ | saudāsanṛpayajñe vai vasiṣṭhātmajaśaktinā | viśvāmitrasyābhibhūtaṃ balaṃ vāk ca samaṃtataḥ | vāsiṣṭhenābhibhūtaḥ sa hyavāsīdatha gādhijaḥ | tasmai brāhmīṃ tu saurīṃ nā nāmnā vācaṃ sasarparīṃ | sūryaveśmana āhṛtya dadurvai jamadagnayaḥ | kuśikānāṃ matiḥ sā vāgamatiṃ tāmapānudat ‖*
> *jamadagnidattā jamadagnibhiḥ prajvalitāgnibhiryaṣibhirasmabhyaṃ dattāmatimajñānaṃ*
> *bādhamānā sasarparīḥ sarvatra śabdarūpatayā sarpaṇaśīlā vāk bṛhatprabhūtaṃ yathā*
> *bhavati tathā mimāya | nabhasi śabdaṃ karoti | saiṣā sūryasya duhitā vāgdevatā deveṣṭviṃdrādiṣvajuryaṃ kṣayarahitamamṛtamamṛtalakṣaṇaṃ śravo 'nnamā tatāna | samaṃtātsvāhākāravācaṃ tanoti ‖ jamadagnidattā! dāṇ dāna ityasyaniṣṭhāyāṃ do dadvo-*

> रिति ददादेशः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वसदप्रकृतिस्वरः । अजुर्युं । ज्ञ वयोहानौ । ऋहलोर्ण्यत् । बहुलं छंदसीत्युत्वं । नञ्सुभ्यामित्यंतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *riti dadādeśaḥ | tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvasadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | ajuryuṃ | jña vayohānau | ṛhalorṇyat | bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyutvaṃ | nañsubhyāmityaṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Those versed in ancient lore tell the story relating to ससर्परी (*sasarparī*) in this Ṛk: at the sacrifice of King Sudāsa, Śakti, son of Vasiṣṭha, overcame the strength and speech of Viśvāmitra on every side; overcome by the Vāsiṣṭha, the son of Gādhi sank down. The Jamadagnis brought for him from the house of the Sun the Brahma-speech called Sasarpari, of solar nature, and gave it. That was the understanding of the Kuśikas, the speech, and it drove off their lack of understanding. जमदग्निदत्ता (*jamadagnidattā*): given to us by the Jamadagnis, the sages with blazing fires; अमतिं (*amatiṃ*) is ignorance; warding it off, ससर्परीः (*sasarparīḥ*), speech, whose nature is to move everywhere in the form of sound, मिमाय (*mimāya*) makes sound in the sky abundantly. This same daughter of the Sun, the goddess Speech, spreads among the gods, Indra and others, अजुर्यं (*ajuryaṃ*) imperishable, अमृतं (*amṛtaṃ*) of the nature of immortality, श्रवः (*śravaḥ*) food, in the form of the utterance of svāhā on all sides. The text continues with grammar on जमदग्निदत्ता (*jamadagnidattā*) (broken off at the end of the window).

This block holds only the grammatical tail of Sāyaṇa's comment on the preceding Ṛk (the forms जमदग्निदत्ता (*jamadagnidattā*) and अजुर्युं (*ajuryuṃ*): the substitution दद (*dada*) for the root, the accent of the compound, and the accent of अजुर्युं (*ajuryuṃ*)). It contains no statement of meaning; the Grammar remarks are left out of the Gist.

Word-to-word meaning

- जमदग्नि दत्ता (*jamadagni dattā*)—she who was given by the sages Jamadagni
- अमतिं (*amatiṃ*)—ignorance
- बाधमाना (*bādhamānā*)—she who destroys
- ससर्परीः (*sasarparīḥ*)—she who pervades everywhere in the form of sound
- बृहत् (*bṛhat*)—abundantly
- मिमाय (*mimāya*)—she who makes sound (in the atmosphere)
- सूरस्य दुहिता (*sūrasya duhitā*)—the daughter of Sūrya, the goddess of speech
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among the gods, Indra and the others
- अजुर्यं (*ajuryaṃ*)—that which is without decay
- अमृतं (*amṛtaṃ*)—that which is eternal
- श्रवः (*śravaḥ*)—food
- आ ततान (*ā tatāna*)—spread out widely

Gist

The goddess of speech, who was given by the sage Jamadagni, who destroys ignorance, who pervades everywhere in the form of sound, who sounds abundantly in the atmosphere, and who is the daughter of Sūrya, has spread widely among the gods, Indra and the others, food that is without decay and eternal.

English translation

The daughter of Surya given by Jamadagni gliding everywhere and dissipating ignorance, has emitted a mighty (sound), and has diffused ambro- sial imperishable food amongst the gods.

Special Topics

Concerning this Ṛk and the next, ससर्परी (*sasarparī*), the ancients tell a story:

ससर्परीद्वचे प्राहुरितिहासं पुराविदः । सौदासनृपयज्ञे वै वसिष्ठात्मजशक्तिना ॥ विश्वामित्रस्याभिभूतं बलं वाक्च समंततः । वासिष्ठेनाभिभूतः स ह्यवासीदथ गाधिजः । तस्मै ब्राह्मीं तु सौरीं ना नाम्मा वाचं ससर्परीं । सूर्यवेश्मन आहृत्य ददुर्वै जमदग्नयः । कुशिकानां मतिः सा वागमतिं तामपानुदत् ॥ (*sasarparīdvace prāhuritihāsaṃ purāvidaḥ | saudāsanṛpayajñe vai vasiṣṭhātmajaśaktinā ‖ viśvāmitrasyābhibhūtaṃ balaṃ vākca samaṃtataḥ | vāsiṣṭhenābhibhūtaḥ sa hyavāsīdatha gādhijaḥ | tasmai brāhmīṃ tu saurīṃ nā nāmmā vācaṃ sasarparīṃ | sūryaveśmana āhṛtya dadurvai jamadagnayaḥ | kuśikānāṃ matiḥ sā vāgamatiṃ tāmapānudat ‖*)

The ancients tell a story concerning these Ṛks. In former times, when the sage Viśvāmitra was conducting the sacrifice of a king named Sudāsa, Śakti, a son of Vasiṣṭha,

paralysed Viśvāmitra's strength and his power of speech. Because of this Viśvāmitra, the son of Gādhi, became devoid of strength and enveloped in ignorance, and had to remain silent, unable to utter mantras and the like. Then the aged sages called Jamadagnis brought from the abode of the Sun (from the orb of the Sun) the speech-power (vāk), endowed with the radiance of Brahman and known as the daughter of the Sun, and gave it to the sage Viśvāmitra. Through it Viśvāmitra and his kinsmen the Kuśikas were freed from the ignorance that had enveloped them and regained good understanding, knowledge, and the power of speech, or of reciting mantras. This is the matter described in this Ṛk and in the next.

जमदग्नि दत्ता (*jamadagni dattā*)—जमदग्निभिः प्रज्वलिताग्निभिर्यषिभिः (*jamadagnibhiḥ prajvalitāgnibhiryaṣibhiḥ*). The Bhāṣyakāra explains the word Jamadagni as sages who take care that the fire in the sacrifice does not go out but always burns well.

For the word Jamadagni, Yāska says जमदग्नयः प्रजमिताग्नयो वा प्रज्वलिताग्नयो वा तैरभिहुतो भवति (*jamadagnayaḥ prajamitāgnayo vā prajvalitāgnayo vā tairabhihuto bhavati*) (Ni. 7-24). That is, he gives the etymology that the word means those who have abundant fire, or those who kindle fires and make them burn well, or those who pray to Agni, "Blaze well in this sacrificial rite."

सूर्यस्य दुहिता (*sūryasya duhitā*)—वाग्देवता (*vāgdevatā*). The Bhāṣyakāra explains it as the goddess of speech, the daughter of Sūrya.

The chief sense of ससर्परीः अमतिं बाधमाना जमदग्नि दत्ता सूर्यस्य दुहिता बृहत् मिमाय देवेषु अजुर्यं अमृतं आ ततान (*sasarparīḥ amatiṃ bādhamānā jamadagni dattā sūryasya duhitā bṛhat mimāya deveṣu ajuryaṃ amṛtaṃ ā tatāna*) is this: the goddess of speech, the daughter of Sūrya, all-pervading, brought by the sage Jamadagnis, removed the ignorance of Viśvāmitra and the others and sounded in the atmosphere; that is, she uttered speech in the form of the svāhā-call, and she also brought and provided for Viśvāmitra and the others the undecaying, ambrosial food that was with Indra and the other gods.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒स॒र्प॒रीर॑भर॒त्तूय॑मे॒भ्योऽधि॒ श्रव॒ः पाञ्च॑जन्यासु कृ॒ष्टिषु॑ ।
सा प॒क्ष्या॒३॒॑ नव्य॒मायु॒र्दधा॑ना॒ यां मे॑ पलस्तिजमद॒ग्नयो॑ द॒दुः ॥ १६ ॥

> *sasarparīrabharattūyamebhyo 'dhi śravaḥ pāñcajanyāsu kṛṣṭiṣu |*
> *sā pakṣyā navyamāyurdadhānā yāṃ me palastijamadagnayo daduḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स सर्परीः । अभरत् । तूयं । विभ्यः । अधि । श्रवः । पांचजन्यासु । कृष्णिषु ।
> सा । पक्ष्या । नव्यं । आयुः । दधाना । यां । मे! पलस्तिजमदग्नयः । ददुः ॥ १६ ॥

> *sa sarparīḥ | abharat | tūyaṃ | vibhyaḥ | adhi | śravaḥ | pāṃcajanyāsu | kṛṣṇiṣu |*
> *sā | pakṣyā | navyaṃ | āyuḥ | dadhānā | yāṃ | me! palastijamadagnayaḥ | daduḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ससर्परीः सर्वत्र गद्यपद्यात्मकत्वेन सर्पणशीला वाग्गेवता पांचजन्यासु
> कृष्टषु। निषादपंचमाश्चत्वारो वर्णा: पंचजनाः। तत्संबंधिनीषु प्रजासु यच्छवोऽन्नं विद्यते
> तन्नोऽस्मभ्यमधि अधिकं यथा भवति तथा तूयं क्षिप्रमभरत्।भरतु।
> संपादयतु। पलस्तिजमदग्नयः पलस्तयः पलिता दीर्घायुषो जमदग्नयो मुनयो यां वाचं
> सूर्यादाहृत्य मे मह्यं ददुरदधुः पक्ष्या पक्षस्यपक्षादिनिर्वाहकस्य सूर्यस्य दुहिता सा वाक् नव्यं
> नवतरमायुरन्नं जीवनं वा दधाना मम
> कुर्वाणा भवतु ॥ पांचजन्यासु । बहिर्देवपंचजनेभ्यश्चति वक्तव्यमिति ञ्राप्रत्ययः।
> इत्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । पक्ष्या । पक्षे भवा । दिगादित्वाद्यत् । तित्स्वरितः । नव्यं ।
> नवशब्दाद्घस्वादित्वात्स्वार्थिको यत् । पलस्तिजमदग्नयः पलस्तयो जमदग्नयः ।
> कर्मधारय समासः । समासस्वरः ॥

> *sasarparīḥ sarvatra gadyapadyātmakatvena sarpaṇaśīlā vāggevatā pāṃcajanyāsu*
> *kṛṣṭaṣu| niṣādapaṃcamāścatvāro varṇā: paṃcajanāḥ|*
> *tatsaṃbaṃdhinīṣu prajāsu yacchavo 'nnaṃ vidyate tanno*
> *'smabhyamadhi adhikaṃ yathā bhavati tathā tūyaṃ kṣipramabharat| bharatu|*
> *saṃpādayatu| palastijamadagnayaḥ palastayaḥ palitā dīrghāyuṣo*
> *jamadagnayo munayo yāṃ vācaṃ sūryādāhṛtya me mahyaṃ*
> *daduradadhuḥ pakṣyā pakṣasyapakṣādinirvāhakasya sūryasya duhitā sā*
> *vāk navyaṃ navataramāyurannaṃ jīvanaṃ vā dadhānā mama*
> *kurvāṇā bhavatu ‖ pāṃcajanyāsu | bahirdevapaṃcajanebhyaścati*
> *vaktavyamiti iāpratyayaḥ|*
> *ittvādādyudāttaḥ | pakṣyā | pakṣe bhavā | digāditvādyat | titsvaritaḥ |*
> *navyaṃ | navaśabdādvasvāditvātsvārthiko yat | palastijamadagnayaḥ*
> *palastayo jamadagnayaḥ |*
> *karmadhāraya samāsaḥ | samāsasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

ससर्परीः (*sasarparīḥ*) is the goddess of speech, who moves everywhere in the form of prose and verse. पांचजन्यासु कृष्टिषु (*pāṃcajanyāsu kṛṣṭiṣu*): the "five peoples" are the four classes (varṇas) with the Niṣāda as the fifth; among the subjects belonging to them, whatever food there is, let her quickly bring that to us, in greater measure (अधि (*adhi*)). पलस्तिजमदग्नयः (*palastijamadagnayaḥ*) are the grey-haired, long-lived sages Jamadagnis, who fetched the Speech from the Sun and gave her to me. पक्ष्या (*pakṣyā*) is the daughter of Sūrya, who manages the fortnight (pakṣa) and the like; may that Speech, bestowing on me newer life, or food, or livelihood (नव्यं आयुः (*navyaṃ āyuḥ*)), be mine.

Word-to-word meaning

- ससर्परीः (*sasarparīḥ*)—the goddess of speech, who spreads everywhere in forms of prose and verse
- पांचजन्यासु (*pāṃcajanyāsu*)—fivefold
- कृष्टिषु (*kṛṣṭiṣu*)—to the people
- श्रवः (*śravaḥ*)—food
- अधि (*adhi*)—abundantly

- तूयं (*tūyaṃ*)—quickly
- अभरत् (*abharat*)—may she procure and give
- पलस्तिजमदग्नयः (*palastijamadagnayaḥ*)—the aged Jamadagnis
- यां (*yāṃ*)—which goddess of speech
- मे (*me*)—to me
- ददुः (*daduḥ*)—offered
- पक्ष्या सा (*pakṣyā sā*)—that goddess of speech, the daughter of the Sun
- नव्यं (*navyaṃ*)—newer
- आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—food, or life
- दधाना (*dadhānā*)—may she go on giving

Gist

May the goddess of speech, who spreads everywhere in forms of prose and verse, procure food abundantly and quickly for the fivefold peoples. May that goddess of speech, the daughter of the Sun, whom the aged Jamadagnis offered to me, go on giving newer life.

English translation

May she, gilding everywhere, quickly bring us food (suited) to the five races of men: may she, the daughter of the sun whom the grey-haired Jamadagnis gave to me, (be) the bestower of new life.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk Viśvāmitra expresses his gratitude for the food and the rest which the goddess of speech had granted in the previous Ṛk, and prays to the goddess of speech.

पंचजन्यासु कृष्टिषु (*paṃcajanyāsu kṛṣṭiṣu*): The word कृष्टयः (*kṛṣṭayaḥ*) is read among the twenty-five words denoting men, such as मनुष्याः (*manuṣyāḥ*) and नराः (*narāḥ*) (Ni. 3-7). पंच कृष्टीनां (*paṃca kṛṣṭīnāṃ*) means पंच जनानां (*paṃca janānāṃ*). The Bhāṣyakāra explains this as निषादपंचमानां (*niṣādapaṃcamānāṃ*); Skandasvāmin as क्षितीनां मनुष्यजातीनां गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा इत्येतासां (*kṣitīnāṃ manuṣyajātīnāṃ gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā ityetāsāṃ*); and Veṅkaṭamādhava as मनुष्याणां पंचानां क्षितीनां निवसतां गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा असुरा रक्षांसीति पंचत्वं (*manuṣyāṇāṃ paṃcānāṃ kṣitīnāṃ nivasatāṃ gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā asurā rakṣāṃsīti paṃcatvaṃ*).

According to Sāyaṇa's view, क्षितीनां (*kṣitīnāṃ*) means the people of five classes fit to dwell on the earth: Brāhmaṇa, Kṣatriya, Vaiśya, Śūdra and Niṣāda. Niṣādas are people who do not belong to the four classes beginning with the Brāhmaṇa and who live only by hunting animals. The Goṇḍas, Kolas, Bhillas and others, the earlier inhabitants of this country, belong to this class. They still live, in very small numbers, only in a few places such as the Central Provinces. The words पंच जनाः (*paṃca janāḥ*) and पंचकृष्टीः (*paṃcakṛṣṭīḥ*) occur in many places in the Ṛgveda—?93

That is, some say that the five peoples are five kinds of beings: Gandharvas, Pitṛs, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas. The opinion of Upamanyu and others is that the five are the four classes beginning with the Brāhmaṇa together with the hunter class called Niṣāda (Sāyaṇa has approved this). The Nairuktas say that Niṣādas are those who kill animals, or that they are so called because sin is full in them. Besides, there may have been five principal tribes at that time; the poet may have had this in mind and said पंच क्षितीनां (*paṃca kṣitīnāṃ*). In any case it is clear that even in the time of Yāska, the author of the Nirukta, there was a difference of opinion on this matter.

1. [Yāska explains the five peoples:] देवा मनुष्याः पितरः पशवः पक्षिणश्चति पंच जनाः (*devā manuṣyāḥ pitaraḥ paśavaḥ pakṣiṇaścati paṃca janāḥ*): the five kinds are the gods, men, Pitṛs, animals and birds; and, secondly,
2. चत्वारो वर्णाः निषादपंचमाः पंच जना इत्यन्ये (*catvāro varṇāḥ niṣādapaṃcamāḥ paṃca janā ityanye*): the people of the four classes together with the Niṣādas, as another explanation. For both these meanings the authority of Vedic texts can be shown. One may first examine the etymology of the word क्षिति (*kṣiti*), and afterwards consider what meaning of पंचक्षिति (*paṃcakṣiti*) can be given in the present context.

क्षितीनां (*kṣitīnāṃ*): Sāyaṇa explains: क्षियंति निवसंति गच्छंति वा क्षितयो मनुष्याः (*kṣiyaṃti nivasaṃti gacchaṃti vā kṣitayo manuṣyāḥ*)—they dwell or they move about; therefore this epithet belongs to men. The author of the Nirukta has read the word क्षिति (*kṣiti*) among the twenty-five names of man beginning with नरः (*naraḥ*) (Ni. 3-7).

अग्निर्नेता भग इव क्षितीनां दैवीनां देव ऋतुपा ऋतुवा । स वृत्रहा सनयो विश्ववेदाः पर्षद्विश्वाति दुरिता गृणंतं । (*agnirnetā bhaga iva kṣitīnāṃ daivīnāṃ deva ṛtupā ṛtuvā | sa vṛtrahā sanayo viśvavedāḥ parṣadviśvāti duritā gṛṇaṃtaṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-28-4). In such Ṛks, when the difference between men and the subjects belonging to the gods is shown, the word क्षिति (*kṣiti*) indicates men, the subjects of the earth. But in the present Ṛk it cannot be said precisely that earthly men alone are meant, because Indra's wealth pervades the whole of earth and atmosphere.

न यस्य देवा देवता न मर्ता आपश्चन शवसो अंशमापुः । स प्ररिक्वा त्वक्षसा क्ष्मो दिवश्च मरुत्वान्नो भवत्स्वंद्र ऊती । (*na yasya devā devatā na martā āpaścana śavaso aṃśamāpuḥ | sa prarikvā tvakṣasā kṣmo divaśca marutvānno bhavatsvaṃdra ūtī* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-100-15). In such Ṛks it is described that the power of Indra, who is divine in nature and endowed with the quality of giving and the like, surpasses the power of all others in the world, that neither gods nor men could reach its end, and that Indra with his enemy-destroying and majestic power makes earth and heaven shine together. Since in the present Ṛk also Indra's wealth is described as all-pervading, it cannot be said that पंचजन्यासु (*paṃcajanyāsu*) means merely the group of four classes together with the Niṣāda as fifth. In this matter the author of the Nirukta does not state his own view but reports only the opinions of others.

पंचजना (*paṃcajanā*) "मम होत्रं जुषध्वं (*mama hotraṃ juṣadhvaṃ*)" गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा आसुरा रक्षांसीत्येके। चत्वारो वर्णा निषादः पंचम इत्यौपमन्यवः । (*gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā āsurā rakṣāṃsītyeke | catvāro varṇā niṣādaḥ paṃcama ityaupamanyavaḥ* |) (Ni. 3-8). He has reported only the opinions of others: that some hold the five-fold groups to be Gandharvas, Pitṛs, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas, and that Upamanyu and others hold that the five peoples are the four classes beginning with the Brāhmaṇa together with the fifth group called Niṣādas.

Formerly, when all the gods prayed to Agni to accept the oblation offered in the sacrifice for them and to distribute it to all, Agni agreed, saying:

तदद्य वाचः प्रथमं मसीय येनासुरा अभि देवा असाम । ऊर्जाद उत यज्ञियासः पंच जना मम होत्रं जुषध्वं । (*tadadya vācaḥ prathamaṃ masīya yenāsurā abhi devā asāma | ūrjāda uta yajñiyāsaḥ paṃca janā mama hotraṃ juṣadhvaṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-53-4).

The author of the Bṛhaddevatā quotes this sentence, which gives the answer "Let the five peoples together enjoy this oblation," and shows and discusses the differences of opinion about the "five peoples."

प्रत्युवाचाथ तानग्निर्विश्वेदेवा यदूच मां । तत्करिष्ये जुषंतां तु होत्रं पंचजना मम ॥ (*pratyuvācātha tānagnirviśvedevā yadūca māṃ | tatkariṣye juṣaṃtāṃ tu hotraṃ paṃcajanā mama ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 7-66).

In this verse he states the answer Agni gave to the gods, and then explains the word पंचजन (*paṃcajana*).

शालामुख्यः प्रणीतश्च पुत्रो गृहपतेश्च यः । उत्तरो दक्षिणश्चाग्निरेते पंचजनाः स्मृताः ॥ (*śālāmukhyaḥ praṇītaśca putro gṛhapateśca yaḥ | uttaro dakṣiṇaścāgnirete paṃcajanāḥ smṛtāḥ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 7-67).

That is, the fire at the entrance of the hall, the consecrated Āhavanīya fire, the Gārhapatya fire, which is the son of the sacrificer, and the southern and northern fires: these five kinds of fires are traditionally reckoned as the five classes. Besides this view,

मनुष्याः पितरो देवा गंधर्वोरगराक्षसाः गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा असुरा यक्षराक्षसाः ॥ (*manuṣyāḥ pitaro devā gaṃdharvoragarākṣasāḥ gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā asurā yakṣarākṣasāḥ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 7-68).

According to the first opinion the serpents and Rākṣasas form one group; according to the second, the Yakṣas and Rākṣasas form one group.

यास्कौपमन्यवावेतानाहतुः पंच वै जनान् । निषादपंचमान्वर्णान् मन्यते शाकटायनः ॥ (*yāskaupamanyavāvetānāhatuḥ paṃca vai janān | niṣādapaṃcamānvarṇān manyate śākaṭāyanaḥ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 7-69).

In this verse the author of the Bṛhaddevatā says that Yāska's view is the first. But in the Nirukta only the views of others are stated; Yāska has not given his own view precisely. Probably he may have accepted that one.

(The Special Topics of the preceding Ṛk continue.)

ऋत्विजो यजमानं च शाकपूणिस्तु मन्यते । (*ṛtvijo yajamānaṃ ca śākapūṇistu manyate* |) (Bṛ. De. 7-20)

It is the view of Śākapūṇi that the four priests beginning with the Hotṛ, together with the sacrificer, make up the group of five.

चक्षुःश्रोत्रं मनो वाक् च प्राणश्चेत्यात्मवादिनः । (*cakṣuḥśrotraṃ mano vāk ca prāṇaścetyātmavādinaḥ* |)

गंधर्वाप्सरसो देवा मनुष्याः पितरस्तथा ॥ (*gaṃdharvāpsaraso devā manuṣyāḥ pitarastathā* ‖)

सर्पाश्च ब्राह्मणे चैव श्रूयंते हैतरेयके॥ (*sarpāśca brāhmaṇe caiva śrūyaṃte haitareyake* ‖) (Bṛ. De. 7-21, 22)

According to the spiritualists, the five peoples are the eye, the ear, the mind, speech and the breath. The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa explains them as the Gandharvas and so on (Ai. Brā. 3-31-5). The Bṛhaddevatā, in explaining that Agni gave the gods the answer "let such five peoples also enjoy the oblation", likewise records these differences of opinion.

पक्ष्या (*pakṣyā*)—पक्षे भवा । (*pakṣe bhavā* |) Because he carries out the divisions of the year such as month and fortnight, the Sun is called "pakṣī". Here the instrumental case of पक्ष्या (*pakṣyā*) is said to have the sense of the genitive.

पलस्तिजमदग्नयः (*palastijamadagnayaḥ*)—पलस्तयः पलितदीर्घायुषो जमदग्नयो मुनयः । (*palastayaḥ palitadīrghāyuṣo jamadagnayo munayaḥ* |) The meaning is: the sages Jamadagni, long-lived, that is, aged men who have lived for a very long time. We explained the derivation of the word Jamadagni in the Special Topics of the previous Ṛk.

The sage Jamadagni is one of the seven sages. The hymns seen by Jamadagni in the Ṛgveda are Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-62-16 to 18 and 10-137-6, four Ṛks in all. The hymns seen by Jamadagni Bhārgava, that is, Jamadagni the son of Bhṛgu: Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-101 (16 Ṛks), 9-62 (30 Ṛks), 9-65 (30 Ṛks), 9-67 (3 Ṛks, verses 16–18); in all 79 Ṛks. Besides, a hymn seen by the two sages Jamadagni and Viśvāmitra together stands in the tenth Maṇḍala, Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-167 (4 Ṛks); in its last verse (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-167-4) the names of Viśvāmitra and Jamadagni are mentioned together. Further, Jamadagni's name is mentioned in Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-79-3; 9-97-51; Atharvaveda 2-32-3; 4-29-3; 5-28-7; 6-137-1; 18-3-15, 16; Tai. Saṃ. 2-2-12-4; 3-1-7-3; 3-52; 5-2-10-5; 4-11-3; Mai. Saṃ. 2-7-19; 4-2-9; Kāṭhaka Saṃhitā 16-19; 20-9; Vā. Saṃ. 3-62; 13-56; Pañcaviṃśa Brāhmaṇa 9-4-14; 13-5-15; 21-10-5 to 7; 22-7-2; Ai. Brā. 7-16; Śa. Brā. 13-2-2-14; Tai. Ā. 1-9-7; Bṛ. U. 2-2-4;

Jaiminīya Upaniṣad Brāhmaṇa 3-3-11; 4-3-1, and other places. In all these places Jamadagni is regarded as a friend of Viśvāmitra. Only in one place in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā is he indicated as an opponent of Vasiṣṭha.

The distinction of this Jamadagni is that he is famed as having played the part of chief priest in a special sacrifice called Caturātra, performed over four days. This is stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā beginning पुष्टिकामश्च तूरात्रेणायजत (*puṣṭikāmaśca tūrātrèṇāyajata*)[?94] and in the Pañcaviṃśa Brāhmaṇa[?95] (21-10-5 to 7). In the Atharvaveda (Atharvaveda 2-32-3; 6-137-1) Jamadagni is mentioned along with the sages Atri, Kaṇva, Asita and Vītahavya. As told in the story of Śunaśśepa in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa (Ai. Brā. 7-16), in Śunaśśepa's sacrifice Jamadagni played the part of the priest called Adhvaryu.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्थि॒रौ गावौ॑ भवतां वी॒ळुरक्षो॒ मेषा वि व॑र्हि॒ मा यु॒गं वि शा॑रि ।
इन्द्र॑ः पात॒ल्ये॑ ददतां॒ शरी॑तो॒ररि॑ष्टनेमे अ॒भि न॑ः सचस्व ॥ १७ ॥

> *sthirau gāvau bhavatāṃ vīḷurakṣo meṣā vi varhi mā yugaṃ vi śāri |*
> *indraḥ pātalye dadatāṃ śarītorariṣṭaneme abhi naḥ sacasva ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्थिरौ । गावौ । भवतां । वीळुः । अक्षः । मा । ईषा । वि । वर्हि । मा । युगं वि शारि ।
> इंद्रः । पातल्येऽति । ददतां । शरीतोः । अरिष्टनेमे । अभि । नः । सचस्व ॥ १७ ॥

> *sthirau | gāvau | bhavatāṃ | vīḷuḥ | akṣaḥ | mā | īṣā | vi | varhi | mā | yugaṃ vi śāri |*
> *iṃdraḥ | pātalye 'ti | dadatāṃ | śarītoḥ | ariṣṭaneme | abhi | naḥ | sacasva ‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> राज्ञः सुदासो यज्ञेऽवभृथं कृत्वा यज्ञशालातो निर्गंतुमिच्छन् रथेऽश्वादिकं युंजानो विश्वामित्रो रथांगानि स्तौति । गावौ । गच्छत इति गावावश्व ।
> स्थिरौ भवतां । अक्षश्च वीळुर्दृढो भवतु । ईषा दंडश्च मा वि वर्हि । वृद्यो मा भवतु । युगं च मा वि शारि । विशीर्णं मा भवतु । इंद्रः पातल्ये पतनशीले कीलके शरीतोर्विशरणात्पाक् ददतां । धारयतु । हे अरिष्टनेमे अहिंसितप्रधिविशिष्ट हे रथ नोऽस्मानभि अभिमुख्येन सचस्व । संगतो भव ॥ वि वर्हि । वृहि वृद्धौ । विपूर्वो वृहिर्विनाशे वर्तते । आस्मात्कर्मकर्तरि लुजि चिन् भावकर्म–

> *rājñaḥ sudāso yajñe 'vabhṛthaṃ kṛtvā yajñaśālāto nirgaṃtumicchan rathe 'śvādikaṃ yuṃjāno viśvāmitro rathāṃgāni stauti | gāvau | gacchata iti gāvāvaśca |*
> *sthirau bhavatāṃ | akṣaśca vīḷurdṛḍho bhavatu | īṣā daṃḍaśca mā vi varhi | vṛdyo mā*

> *bhavatu | yugaṃ ca mā vi śāri | viśīrṇaṃ mā bhavatu | iṃdraḥ pātalye patanaśīle*
> *kīlake śarītorviśaraṇātpāk dadatāṃ | dhārayatu | he ariṣṭaneme ahiṃsitapradhiviśiṣṭa he ratha no 'smānabhi abhimukhyena sacasva | saṃgato bhava || vi varhi | vṛhi*
> *vṛddhau | vipūrvo vṛhirvināśe vartate | āsmātkarmakartari luji cin bhāvakarma-*

> षोरिति चिण् । चिणो लुगिति तप्रत्ययस्य लुक् । निघातः । युगं । युगशब्द उंभादिषु
> रथाद्युपकरणेऽर्थे घइंतत्वेन निपातनादगुणत्वं । तत्र पाठादंतोदात्तत्वं ।
> शारि । शृ हिंसायामित्यस्य लुजि रूपं । अरिष्टनेमे । पादादित्वात् षाष्ठिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *ṣoriti ciṇ | ciṇo lugiti tapratyayasya luk | nighātaḥ | yugaṃ | yugaśabda uṃbhādiṣu rathādyupakaraṇe 'rthe ghaiṃtatvena nipātanādaguṇatvaṃ | tatra pāṭhādaṃtodāttatvaṃ |*
> *śāri | śṛ hiṃsāyāmityasya luji rūpaṃ | ariṣṭaneme | pādāditvāt ṣāṣṭhikamādyudāttatvaṃ ||*

Summary

At King Sudās's sacrifice Viśvāmitra, having performed the concluding bath (avabhṛtha) and wishing to leave the sacrificial hall, yokes the horses and the rest to the chariot and praises the parts of the chariot. गावौ (*gāvau*) are the two that go (gacchataḥ); may the two be steady. May the axle be firm and strong. May the pole (īṣā) not be वृद्यो (*vṛdyo*) [sic as in the block]; may the yoke not split, not be shattered. May Indra hold the peg (pātalya), which is prone to fall, before it breaks. O chariot with unharmed felly (ariṣṭanemi), be joined with us, facing us. The rest of the block begins the derivation of वि वर्हि (*vi varhi*) from the root वृहि (*vṛhi*) (to grow), meaning destruction when preceded by वि (*vi*) (grammatical).

The block contains only grammatical notes (on वि वर्हि (*vi varhi*), युगं (*yugaṃ*), शारि (*śāri*), अरिष्टनेमे (*ariṣṭaneme*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- गावः (*gāvaḥ*)—the horses
- स्थिरौ (*sthirau*)—steady
- भवतां (*bhavatāṃ*)—let them be

- अक्षः (*akṣaḥ*)—the axle
- वीळुः (*vīḷuḥ*)—let it be firm
- ईषा (*īṣā*)—the pole in the middle of the chariot
- मा वि वर्हि (*mā vi varhi*)—let it not be destroyed
- युगं च (*yugaṃ ca*)—the yoke also
- मा वि शारि (*mā vi śāri*)—let it not split
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- पातल्ये (*pātalye*)—the pegs of the chariot
- शरीतोः (*śarītoḥ*)—before they split
- ददतां (*dadatāṃ*)—let him hold
- अरिष्टनेमे (*ariṣṭaneme*)—O chariot with unharmed felly
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- अभि (*abhi*)—all around
- सचस्व (*sacasva*)—keep joined

Gist

Let the horses of our chariot be steady. Let its axle be firm. Let the pole in the middle of the chariot not be destroyed, and the yoke not split. Before the pegs of the chariot split, let Indra hold them. O chariot with unharmed felly, keep joined with us.

English translation

May the horses be steady, the axle be strong, the pole be not defective: the yoke not be rotten; may Indra preserve the two yoke-pins from decay . car with the uninjured fellies, be ready for us.

Special Topics

At the close of King Sudās's sacrifice Viśvāmitra takes the avabhṛtha bath, prepares to leave the sacrificial hall, yokes horses to the chariot, and praises the chariot's parts, that is, wheel, felly, yoke and so on.

गावौ स्थिरौ भवतां (*gāvau sthirau bhavatāṃ*)—गवावश् (*gavāvaś*). Here the horses are addressed by the word "go" (cow). Hence गावौ (*gāvau*) means the two horses yoked to the chariot. The wish is expressed that they be steady, free from fear.

वीळु अक्ष (*vīḷu akṣa*)—the axle of the chariot, that is, the axle-beam between the two wheels. May it be firm, so that it does not break under the weight on a journey.

ईषा मा वि वर्हि (*īṣā mā vi varhi*)—दंडश्च व्यृद्वो मा भवतु । (*daṃḍaśca vyṛdvo mā bhavatu* |) The pole in the middle of the chariot, that is, the long beam fitted with its fastening, is not to be spoilt.

मा युगं वि शारि (*mā yugaṃ vi śāri*)—विशीर्णं मा भवतु । (*viśīrṇaṃ mā bhavatu* |) Let the yoke not split apart.

इंद्रः पातल्ये शरीतो ददतां (*iṃdraḥ pātalye śarīto dadatāṃ*)—पतनशीले कीलके विशरणात् प्राक् इंद्रः धारयतु । (*patanaśīle kīlake viśaraṇāt prāk iṃdraḥ dhārayatu* |) If the pegs are likely to break and fall, may Indra, before they break and fall, hold them firmly so that they do not fall.

अरिष्टनेमे नः अभि सचस्व (*ariṣṭaneme naḥ abhi sacasva*)—अहिंसितप्रधिविशिष्ट हे रथ अस्मानाभिमुख्येन संगतो भव । (*ahiṃsitapradhiviśiṣṭa he ratha asmānābhimukhyena saṃgato bhava* |) O chariot with wheels that harm no one, make ready to depart and come and stand in front of us.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

बलं॑ धेहि त॒नूषुं॑ नो॒ बलं॑मिन्द्रान॒ळुत्सुं॑ नः ।
बलं॑ तो॒काय॒ तनं॑याय जी॒वसे॒ त्वं हि बं॑ल॒दा अ
सिं॑ ॥ १८ ॥

> *balaṃ dhehi tanūṣu no balamindrānaḷutsu naḥ |*
> *balaṃ tokāya tanayāya jīvase tvaṃ hi baladā asi ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> बलं । धेहि । तनूषु । नः । बलं । इंद्र । अनळुत्सु । नः ।
> बलं । तोकाय । तनयाय । जीवसे । त्वं । हि । बलदाः । असि ॥ १८ ॥

> *balaṃ | dhehi | tanūṣu | naḥ | balaṃ | iṃdra | anaḷutsu | naḥ |*
> *balaṃ | tokāya | tanayāya | jīvase | tvaṃ | hi | baladāḥ | asi ‖ 18 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र नोऽस्माकं तनूषु शरीरेषु बलं धेहि । नोऽस्मत्संबंधिरथवाहेष्टनळुत्सु बलं धेहि । तोकाय पुत्राय तनयाय पौत्राय च जीवसे चिरं
> जीवनाय बलमायुर्विधेहि । एतादृशं दातृत्वं कुत इत्यत आह। त्वं बलदाः। बलं
> ददातीति बलदाः । असि हि । सर्वेषु लोकेषु प्रसिद्धोऽसि खलु ॥ अनळुत्तु । वह
> प्रापणे । अनसि वहेः क्विबनसो दश्चेति क्विप् । अनसः सकारस्य दत्वं । वहेय्यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । वसुस्रंसुध्वंस्वनडुहां द इति हकारस्य दत्वं । कृदुत्तरस्वरः ।
> असि । हियोगादनिघातः । सिपः पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he iṃdra no 'smākaṃ tanūṣu śarīreṣu balaṃ dhehi | no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhirathavāheṣṭanaḷutsu balaṃ dhehi | tokāya putrāya tanayāya pautrāya ca jīvase ciraṃ*
> *jīvanāya balamāyurvidhehi | etādṛśaṃ dātṛtvaṃ kuta ityata āha| tvaṃ baladāḥ| balaṃ*
> *dadātīti baladāḥ | asi hi | sarveṣu lokeṣu prasiddho 'si khalu ‖ anaḷuttu | vaha*
> *prāpaṇe | anasi vaheḥ kvibanaso daśceti kvip | anasaḥ sakārasya datvaṃ | vaheyyajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | vasusraṃsudhvaṃsvanaḍuhāṃ da iti hakārasya datvaṃ | kṛduttarasvaraḥ |*
> *asi | hiyogādanighātaḥ | sipaḥ pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, place strength in our bodies; place strength in the animals that draw our chariot (अनळुत्सु (*anaḷutsu*)); for our son and grandson, for long life, bestow strength and long life. Whence such giving? He says: you are बलदाः (*baladāḥ*), giver of strength; for you are renowned thus in all the worlds. The remainder explains अनळुत्सु (*anaḷutsu*) from the root वह (*vaha*) and the accents of असि (*asi*) (grammatical).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—our

- तनूषु (*tanūṣu*)—in the bodies
- बलं (*balaṃ*)—strength
- धेहि (*dhehi*)—give
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- अनळुत्सु (*anaḷutsu*)—to the vehicles (the horses); बलं (*balaṃ*)—give strength
- तोकाय (*tokāya*)—to the son
- तनयाय (*tanayāya*)—to the grandson
- जीवसे (*jīvase*)—for a long life
- बलं (*balaṃ*)—give strength
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- बलदाः असि हि (*baladāḥ asi hi*)—it is well known that you are the giver of strength

Gist

O Indra, fill our bodies with strength. Give strength to our vehicles. Make strength for our sons and grandsons, that they may be long-lived. It is well known that you are the giver of strength to all.

English translation

Give strength, Indra, to our bodies; give strength to our vehicles; (give) strength to our sons and grandsons; that they may live (long); for you are the giver of strength,

Special Topics

In this Ṛk it is prayed that Indra, being mighty, give strength on the journey to us, to the sons, grandsons and others who are with us, and to our vehicles, horses and the rest, and protect them from accidents and the like.

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒भि व्य॑यस्व खदि॒रस्य॒ सार॒मोजो॑ धेहि स्पन्द॒ने शिं॒शपा॑याम् ।
अक्ष॑ वीळो वीळित वी॒ळय॑स्व॒ मा यामा॑द॒स्मादव॑ जीहिपो नः ॥ १९ ॥

> *abhi vyayasva khadirasya sāramojo dhehi spandane śiṃśapāyām |*
> *akṣa vīḷo vīḷita vīḷayasva mā yāmādasmādava jīhipo naḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभि । व्ययस्व । खदिरस्य । सारं । ओजः । धेहि । स्पंदने । शिंशपायां ।
> अक्ष । वीळो इति । वीळित । वीळयस्व । मा । यामात् । अस्मात् । अव । जीहिपः ।
> नः ॥ १९ ॥

> *abhi | vyayasva | khadirasya | sāraṃ | ojaḥ | dhehi | spaṃdane |*
> *śiṃśapāyāṃ |*
> *akṣa | vīḷo iti | vīḷita | vīḷayasva | mā | yāmāt | asmāt | ava | jīhipaḥ |*
> *naḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र खदिरस्य सारं । सारेण हि आणिः क्रियते । तं खदिरस्य सारभूतमाणिमभि व्ययस्व ।
> अभितस्तत्तत्सा नेषु दार्ढार्थं निधेहि । स्पंदने रथस्य गमने सति
> शिंतपायां शिंशपाख्यदारुनिर्मिते रथस्य फलक ओजो धेहि । दार्ढ्यं कुरु । हे

> *he iṃdra khadirasya sāraṃ | sāreṇa hi āṇiḥ kriyate | taṃ khadirasya*
> *sārabhūtamāṇimabhi vyayasva | abhitastattatsā neṣu dārḍhārthaṃ*
> *nidhehi | spaṃdane rathasya gamane sati*
> *śiṃtapāyāṃ śiṃśapākhyadārunirmite rathasya phalaka ojo dhehi |*
> *dārḍhyaṃ kuru | he*

> वीळो दृढ वीळितास्माभिर्दृढीकृत हे अक्ष वीळयस्व । त्वं दृढो भव । यद्वास्मान्
> दृढीकुरु । यामाद्गच्छतोस्माद्रथान्नोऽस्मान् माव जीहिपः । मा पीपतः ॥
> खदिरस्य । अजिरशितिरेत्यादिना किरच् प्रत्ययांतत्वेन निपातनादंतोदात्तः । वीळित ।

> वीळयतेर्ण्यंतस्य निष्ठायामिडागमः । निष्ठायां सेटि! पा. ६–४–५२। इति णेर्लुक् ।
> वीळियस्व । आमंत्रितस्याविद्यमानत्वेन पादादित्वादनिघातः । यामात् । या प्रापण
> इत्यस्मादर्तिस्तु सुहुसृ इत्यादिना मन्प्रत्ययः । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । जीहिपः । ओहाक्
> त्यागे । ण्यंतस्य लुजि चङि रूपं । अकारस्येकारश्चांदसः ॥

> *vīḷo dṛḍha vīḷitāsmābhirdṛḍhīkṛta he akṣa vīḷayasva | tvaṃ dṛḍho bhava | yadvāsmān*
> *dṛḍhīkuru | yāmāddhacchatosmādrathānno 'smān māva jīhipaḥ | mā pīpataḥ ‖*
> *khadirasya | ajiraśitiretyādinā kirac pratyayāṃtatvena*
> *nipātanādaṃtodāttaḥ | vīḷita |*
> *vīḷayaterṇyaṃtasya niṣṭhāyāmiḍāgamaḥ | niṣṭhāyāṃ seṭi! pā. 6-4-52| iti ṇerluk |*
> *vīḷiyasva | āmaṃtritasyāvidyamānatvena pādāditvādanighātaḥ | yāmāt | yā prāpaṇa*
> *ityasmādartistu suhusṛ ityādinā manpratyayaḥ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ | jīhipaḥ | ohāk*
> *tyāge | ṇyaṃtasya luji caṅi rūpaṃ | akārasyekāraścāṃdasaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, खदिरस्य सारं (*khadirasya sāraṃ*): the linchpin (āṇi) is made of heartwood; fix that linchpin of khadira heartwood all about, in the several places, for firmness. When the chariot is in motion (spandana), give strength to the board (phalaka) of the chariot made of the wood called śiṃśapā; make it firm. O

(continuing) O firm axle, made firm by us, make yourself firm; or else make us firm. From this chariot as it goes, do not let us fall (मा पीपतः (*mā pīpataḥ*)). The rest is grammatical (खदिरस्य (*khadirasya*), वीळित (*vīḷita*), वीळियस्व (*vīḷiyasva*), यामात् (*yāmāt*), जीहिपः (*jīhipaḥ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- खदिरस्य (*khadirasya*)—of the khadira tree
- सारं (*sāraṃ*)—the linchpin made of its heartwood
- अभि व्ययस्य (*abhi vyayasya*)—fix so that it be firm
- स्पंदने (*spaṃdane*)—while the chariot goes

- शिंशपायां (*śiṃśapāyāṃ*)—to the boards made of śiṃśapā wood
- ओजः (*ojaḥ*)—strength
- धेहि (*dhehi*)—give
- वीळः (*vīḷaḥ*)—firm
- अक्ष (*akṣa*)—O axle
- वीळितः (*vīḷitaḥ*)—since fixed firmly by us
- वीळयस्प (*vīḷayaspa*)—be firm yourself
- यामात् (*yāmāt*)—when we are going in the chariot
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- मा अव जीहिपः (*mā ava jīhipaḥ*)—do not make us fall down

Gist

O Indra, fix the linchpin, made of the heartwood of the khadira tree, so that it is firm. While the chariot is going, give strength to the boards made of śiṃśapā wood. O firm axle, since you have been fixed firmly by us, be firm yourself. When we are going in the chariot, do not make us fall down.

English translation

Fix firmly the substance of the Khayar (axle), give solidity to the shishu (floor) of the car : strong axle, strongly fixed by us, be strong ; cast us not from out of our conveyance.

Special Topics

इंद्र खदिरस्य सारं अभि व्ययस्व (*iṃdra khadirasya sāraṃ abhi vyayasva*)—खदिरस्य सारभूतमाणिं अभितस्तत्तत्स्थानेषु दार्ढार्थ्यर्थं निधेहि । (*khadirasya sārabhūtamāṇiṃ abhitastattatsthāneṣu dārḍhārthyarthaṃ nidhehi* |) The ends of the axle fitted into the holes at the middle of the wheels are called linchpins (āṇi). If the wheel comes off from this linchpin, the chariot falls apart. Therefore the prayer is: with the ends of the axle-beam, made strong of khadira wood, make the chariot wheels stand firm so that they do not slip off.

स्पंदने शिंशपायां ओजः धेहि (*spaṃdane śiṃśapāyāṃ ojaḥ dhehi*)—रथस्य गमने सति शिंशपाख्यदारुनिर्मिते रथस्य फलक ओजो धेहि । (*rathasya gamane sati śiṃśapākhyadārunirmite rathasya phalaka ojo dhehi* |) दार्ढ्यं कुरु (*dārḍhyaṃ kuru*). Make the boards of śiṃśapā wood in the chariot stay firm, neither shaking nor breaking, while the chariot goes fast.

In the same way, the prayer that the axle-tree too (akṣa) should be firm and not let us fall while the chariot is travelling has been explained.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यम॒स्मान्वन॒स्पति॒र्मा च॒ हा मा च॑ रीरिषत् ।
स्व॒स्त्या गृ॒हेभ्य॒ आव॒सा आ वि॒मोच॑नात् ॥ २० ॥

> *ayamasmānvanaspatirmā ca hā mā ca rīriṣat |*
> *svastyā gṛhebhya āvasā ā vimocanāt ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । अस्मान् । वनस्पतिः । मा । च । हाः । मा । च । रिरिषत् ।
> स्वस्ति । आ । गृहेभ्यः । आ । अवस्यै । आ । विमोचनात् ॥ २० ॥

> *ayaṃ | asmān | vanaspatiḥ | mā | ca | hāḥ | mā | ca | ririṣat |*
> *svasti | ā | gṛhebhyaḥ | ā | avasyai | ā | vimocanāt ‖ 20 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यजमान आत्मनः श्रेय आशास्ते । वनस्पतिर्वनस्पतिनिर्मितोऽयं रथो
> रथारूढानस्मान् मा च हाः । मा त्याक्षीत् । किंच मा रीरिषत् । आस्मान् मा विनाशयतु ।
> किंचा गृहेभ्यः । यावद्गृहान् प्राप्नुयाम तावदस्मभ्यं स्वस्ति भवतु ।
> तथावसै । पंचम्यर्थे चतुर्थि । यावद्रथवेगावसानं तावत् । आ विमोचनात् ।
> यावद्रथयोजिताश्वविमोचनं तावत् स्वस्ति भवतु ॥ हाः । ओहाक् त्यागे ; लुजि
> मंत्रे घसेत्यादिना सिचो लुक् । पुरुषव्यत्ययः । चवायोगे प्रथमेति न
> निघातः । रीरिषत् । रिष हिंसायामित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लुजि चजि रूपं । द्वितीयत्वान्निघातः ।
> गृहेभ्यः । ग्रहेर्गेहे क इति कः । पंचम्यपाङ्परिभिरिति पंचमी । अवसै ।
> षोऽंतकर्मणि । क्विप् । चतुर्थैकवचन आतो लोपाभावश्चांदसः । वृद्धिः । एकादेशस्वरः ॥

> *yajamāna ātmanaḥ śreya āśāste | vanaspatirvanaspatinirmito 'yaṃ ratho rathārūḍhānasmān mā ca hāḥ | mā tyākṣīt | kiṃca mā rīriṣat | āsmān mā vināśayatu | kiṃcā gṛhebhyaḥ | yāvadgṛhān prāpnuyāma tāvadasmabhyaṃ svasti bhavatu | tathāvasai | paṃcamyarthe caturthi | yāvadrathavegāvasānaṃ tāvat | ā vimocanāt | yāvadrathayojitāśvavimocanaṃ tāvat svasti bhavatu ‖ hāḥ | ohāk tyāge ; luji maṃtre ghasetyādinā sico luk | puruṣavyatyayaḥ | cavāyoge prathameti na nighātaḥ | rīriṣat | riṣa hiṃsāyāmityasya ṇyaṃtasya luji caji rūpaṃ | dvitīyatvānnighātaḥ | gṛhebhyaḥ | grahergehe ka iti kaḥ | paṃcamyapāṅparibhiriti paṃcamī | avasai | ṣo 'ṃtakarmaṇi | kvip | caturthaikavacana āto lopābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ | vṛddhiḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

The sacrificer asks for his own welfare. The lord of the forest (वनस्पतिः (*vanaspatiḥ*)) is this chariot, made of wood: may it not abandon (हाः (*hāḥ*), from the root ओहाक् (*ohāk*), to leave) us who are mounted on it. May it not harm (रीरिषत् (*rīriṣat*)) us, that is, may it not destroy us. Further, until we reach our homes (गृहेभ्यः (*gṛhebhyaḥ*)) let there be well-being for us. Likewise अवसै (*avasai*): the dative stands in the sense of the ablative; "until the end of the chariot's speed". आ विमोचनात् (*ā vimocanāt*): until the unyoking of the horses harnessed to the chariot, let there be well-being.

Word-to-word meaning

- वनस्पतिः (*vanaspatiḥ*)—made of wood
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this chariot
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us
- मा च हाः (*mā ca hāḥ*)—may it not abandon (not neglect)
- मा च रीरिषत् (*mā ca rīriṣat*)—may it not harm
- आ गृहेभ्यः (*ā gṛhebhyaḥ*)—until we reach home
- स्वस्ति (*svasti*)—may it be well

- आ अवस्यै (*ā avasyai*)—until the chariot's travelling ends, may it be well with us
- आ विमोचनात् (*ā vimocanāt*)—until the horse is unyoked from the chariot, may it be well with us

Gist

May this chariot, made of the lord of the forest, not abandon us. May it not harm us. Until we reach home, may it be well with us. Until the chariot's travelling ends, may it be well with us. Until the horse is unyoked from the chariot, may it be well with us.

English translation

May this lord of the forest never desert us nor do us harm : may we travel prosperously home until the stopping (of the car), until the unharness- ing (of the steeds).

Special Topics

Here the chariot is called by the word vanaspati, because the chariot is made of wood (vanaspati = tree). The prayer is stated that such a chariot may bring us good fortune, so that no kind of trouble befalls us on our journey until we reach our home.

Ṛk 21

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्रो॒तिभि॑र्बहु॒लाभि॑र्नो अ॒द्य या॑च्छ्रे॒ष्ठाभि॑र्मघवञ्छूर जिन्व ।
यो नो॒ द्वेष्ट्यध॑र॒ः सस्प॑दीष्ट॒ यमु॑ द्वि॒ष्मस्तमु॑ प्रा॒णो ज॑हातु ॥ २१ ॥

> *indrotibhirbahulābhirno adya yācchreṣṭhābhirmaghavañchūra jinva |*
> *yo no dveṣṭyadharaḥ saspadīṣṭa yamu dviṣmastamu prāṇo jahātu ‖ 21 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । ऊतिभिः । बहुलाभिः । नः । अद्य । यार्श्रेष्ठाभिः । मघवन् । शूर ।
> जिन्व ।
> यः । नः । द्वेष्टि । अधरः । सः । पदीष्ट । यं । ऊं इति । द्विस्मः । तं । ऊं इति ।
> प्राणः । जहातु ॥ २१ ॥

> *iṃdra | ūtibhiḥ | bahulābhiḥ | naḥ | adya | yārśreṣṭhābhiḥ | maghavan | śūra |*
> *jinva |*
> *yaḥ | naḥ | dveṣṭi | adharaḥ | saḥ | padīṣṭa | yaṃ | ūṃ iti | dvismaḥ | taṃ | ūṃ iti |*
> *prāṇaḥ | jahātu ‖ 21 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंद्रोतिभिरित्याद्याश्चतस्रो वसिष्ठद्वेषिण्यः । पुरा खलु विश्वामित्रशिष्यः सुदा
> नाम राजर्षिरासीत् । स च केनचित्कारणेन वसिष्ठद्वेष्योऽभूत् । विश्वामितस्तु
> शिष्यस्य रक्षार्थमाभिर्यग्निर्वसिष्ठमशपत् । इमा अभिशापरूपाः । ता ऋचो वसिष्ठा
> न शृण्वंति ॥
> परस्य शापं करिष्यन् आदावात्मनो रक्षां कुरुते प्रथमेनार्धर्चेन । हे
> शूर शौर्यवन्नराभिभवशक्त हे मघवन्दनवन्निंद्र अद्यास्मिन्याले यात् । यातयतिर्वधकर्मा ।
> यातयतीति यात् । सुपां सुलुगिति शपो लुक् । यातः शत्रून्
> हिंसतो नोऽस्थानूतिभिस्त्वदीयाभी रक्षाभिर्जिन्व । प्रीणय । कीदृशीभिः । बहुलाभिर्बह्वीभिः
> श्रेष्ठाभिः प्रशस्यतराभिः । अथ शपति । नोऽस्मान्यः शत्रुर्द्वैष्यो द्वैष्ट्यस्मद्विषयामप्रीतिं
> करोति सोऽधरो निकृष्टः सन् पदीष्ट । पततु । वयं च यमु
> द्विष्मस्तमु तं द्वेष्यं प्राणो देहमध्ये वर्तमानः पंचवृत्तिर्वायुर्जहातु ।
> परित्यजतु । उशब्दौ पूरकौ ॥

> *iṃdrotibhirityādyāścatasro vasiṣṭhadveṣiṇyaḥ | purā khalu viśvāmitraśiṣyaḥ sudā*
> *nāma rājarṣirāsīt | sa ca kenacitkāraṇena vasiṣṭhadveṣyo 'bhūt | viśvāmitastu*
> *śiṣyasya rakṣārthamābhiryagnirvasiṣṭhamaśapat | imā abhiśāparūpāḥ | tā ṛco vasiṣṭhā*
> *na śṛṇvaṃti ‖*
> *parasya śāpaṃ kariṣyan ādāvātmano rakṣāṃ kurute prathamenārdharcena | he*
> *śūra śauryavannarābhibhavaśakta he maghavandanavanniṃdra*

> *adyāsminyāle yāt | yātayatirvadhakarmā | yātayatīti yāt | supāṃ sulugiti śapo luk | yātaḥ śatrūn*
> *hiṃsato no 'sthānūtibhistvadīyābhī rakṣābhirjinva | prīṇaya | kīdṛśībhiḥ | bahulābhirbahvībhiḥ śreṣṭhābhiḥ praśasyatarābhiḥ | atha śapati | no 'smānyaḥ śatrurdvaiṣyo dvaiṣṭyasmadviṣayāmaprītiṃ karoti so 'dharo nikṛṣṭaḥ san padīṣṭa | patatu | vayaṃ ca yamu*
> *dviṣmastamu taṃ dveṣyaṃ prāṇo dehamadhyè vartamānaḥ paṃcavṛttirvāyurjahātu |*
> *parityajatu | uśabdau pūrakau ‖*

Summary

This verse and the three following are directed against Vasiṣṭha. Formerly Sudās, a royal seer, was a disciple of Viśvāmitra; for some reason he became hated by Vasiṣṭha. To protect his disciple Viśvāmitra cursed Vasiṣṭha with these verses. These verses are of the nature of imprecations; the Vasiṣṭhas do not listen to these ṛcs.

Intending to curse another, he first secures his own protection with the first half-verse. O hero, able to overcome enemies, O wealthy (मघवन् (*maghavan*)) Indra, today (यात् (*yāt*); the root यातयति (*yātayati*) has the sense of killing) protect and please us who are slaying enemies, with your many (बहुलाभिः (*bahulābhiḥ*)) and most excellent (श्रेष्ठाभिः (*śreṣṭhābhiḥ*)) protections. Then he curses: the enemy who hates us, making ill-will towards us, let him, being low (अधरः (*adharaḥ*)), fall (पदीष्ट (*padīṣṭa*)). And him whom we hate, let the breath (प्राणः (*prāṇaḥ*)), the five-fold wind abiding within the body, abandon. The two उ (*u*) are expletives.

Word-to-word meaning

- शूर (*śūra*)—O mighty one
- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy one
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- यात् (*yāt*)—us who are confronting enemies
- बहुलाभिः (*bahulābhiḥ*)—of many kinds
- श्रेष्ठाभिः (*śreṣṭhābhiḥ*)—excellent
- ऊतिभिः (*ūtibhiḥ*)—with protections

- जिन्व (*jinva*)—satisfy
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- यः (*yaḥ*)—whichever enemy
- द्वेष्टि (*dveṣṭi*)—hates
- सः (*saḥ*)—he
- अधरः (*adharaḥ*)—being low
- पदीष्ट (*padīṣṭa*)—may he fall down
- यमु (*yamu*)—whom
- द्विष्मः (*dviṣmaḥ*)—we hate
- तं (*taṃ*)—him
- प्राणः (*prāṇaḥ*)—the breath
- जहातु (*jahātu*)—may it abandon

Gist

O mighty and wealthy Indra, satisfy us, who confront enemies, with your many and excellent protections. May the enemy who hates us fall down, brought low. May he whom we hate die.

English translation

Indra, hero, possessor of wealth, protect us this day against our foes with many and excellent defences : may the vile wretch who hates us fall (before us) ; may the breath of life depart from him whom we hate.

Special Topics

This ṛc, beginning इंद्रोतिभिः (*iṃdrotibhiḥ*), and the three following express the hatred of the seer Viśvāmitra toward the seer Vasiṣṭha. Formerly there was a royal seer named Sudās, a disciple of Viśvāmitra. For another reason he earned Vasiṣṭha's hatred and became his enemy. To protect his disciple, Viśvāmitra cursed and reviled Vasiṣṭha with these four ṛcs. Therefore these ṛcs are of the nature of imprecation. The descendants of Vasiṣṭha do not listen to these ṛcs.

Before cursing another, the seer desires his own protection; in the first half of this ṛc he asks for his own protection from Indra, and in the second half he asks for the subduing of the enemy. Since the meaning of this ṛc is clear, explanation is unnecessary. In the second half it is explained who our enemies are. Indra is prayed that evil may befall both kinds of enemy: those whom we hate and those who hate us. In the Yajurveda and other texts these two kinds of enemy are described, repeatedly, by the sentence योऽस्मान् द्वेष्टि यं च वयं द्विष्मः (*yo 'smān dveṣṭi yaṃ ca vayaṃ dviṣmaḥ*).

Ṛk 22

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प॒र॒शुं चि॒द्वि तं॑पति शिम्ब॒लं चि॒द्वि वृं॑श्चति ।
उ॒खा चिं॑दिन्द्र॒ येषं॑न्ती॒ प्रयं॑स्ता॒ फेनं॑मस्यति ॥ २२ ॥

> *paraśuṃ cidvi tapati śimbalaṃ cidvi vṛścati |*
> *ukhā cidindra yeṣantī prayastā phenamasyati ‖ 22 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परशुं । चित् । वि । तपति । शिंबलं । चित् । वि । वृश्चति ।
> उखा । चित् । इंद्र । येषंती । प्रयस्ता । फेनं । अस्यति ॥ २२ ॥

> *paraśuṃ | cit | vi | tapati | śiṃbalaṃ | cit | vi | vṛścati |*
> *ukhā | cit | iṃdra | yeṣaṃtī | prayastā | phenaṃ | asyati ‖ 22 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> परशुं चित् । चिच्छब्दः उपमार्थः । यथा परशुं कुठारं प्राप्य वृक्षो वि
> तपति विशिष्टतापयुक्तो भवति । एवं मदीयो द्वेष्टा वितसतु । शिंबलं चित्
> शल्मलीकुसुमं यथानायासेन वि वृश्चति विच्छिद्यते । एवं स द्वेष्टा विवृश्चति । विच्छिन्नावयवो
> भवतु । प्रयस्ता प्रहता येषंती स्रवंत्युखा चित् स्थालीव स द्वेष्टा
> मदीयमंत्रसामर्थ्येन प्रहतः सन् फेनमस्यति । फेनं मुखादुद्गिरतु ॥

> *paraśuṃ cit | cicchabdaḥ upamārthaḥ | yathā paraśuṃ kuṭhāraṃ prāpya vṛkṣo vi*
> *tapati viśiṣṭatāpayukto bhavati | evaṃ madīyo dveṣṭā vitasatu | śiṃbalaṃ cit*

> *śalmalīkusumaṃ yathānāyāsena vi vṛścati vicchidyate | evaṃ sa dveṣṭā vivṛścati | vicchinnāvayavo bhavatu | prayastā prahatā yeṣaṃtī sravaṃtyukhā cit sthālīva sa dveṣṭā madīyamaṃtrasāmarthyena prahataḥ san phenamasyati | phenaṃ mukhāduddiratu ‖*

Summary

चित् (*cit*) has the sense of comparison. As a tree, on meeting the axe (परशुं (*paraśuṃ*)), is subjected to a special torment (वि तपति (*vi tapati*)), so may my enemy be tormented. As the Śālmalī flower (शिंबलं (*śiṃbalaṃ*)) is cut off without effort, so may that enemy be cut off, with his limbs severed. As a pot (उखा (*ukhā*)), struck and leaking, so may that enemy, struck by the power of my mantra, throw up foam (फेनं (*phenaṃ*)) from his mouth.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- परशुं चित् (*paraśuṃ cit*)—as a tree struck by an axe is wounded (so may our enemy too be wounded and tormented)
- वितपति (*vitapati*)—is tormented
- शिंबलं चित् (*śiṃbalaṃ cit*)—as the Śālmalī flower
- वि वृश्चत् (*vi vṛścat*)—falls easily down from its branch (so may my enemy fall effortlessly to the ground)
- प्रयस्ता (*prayastā*)—cracked
- येषंती (*yeṣaṃtī*)—leaking
- उखा चित् (*ukhā cit*)—as a pot lets water leak
- फेनं अस्यति (*phenaṃ asyati*)—(so may my enemy too) pour foam from his mouth

Gist

O Indra, as a tree struck by an axe is wounded, so may our enemy too be wounded and tormented. As the Śālmalī flower falls easily from its stalk, so may my enemy fall effortlessly to the ground. As a cracked, leaking pot lets its water out, so may my enemy too pour foam from his mouth.

English translation

As (the tree) suffers pain from the axe, as the Simal flower is (easily) cut off, as the injured cauldron leaking scatters foam, so may my enemy perish.

Special Topics

In this ṛc it is explained through three illustrations how the enemy comes to ruin.

परशुं चित् वि तपति (*paraśuṃ cit vi tapati*): as a tree, when cut with an axe, feels from the blows an unbearable torment (sorrow), so may one who is our enemy be tormented with sorrow. The word चित् (*cit*) in this ṛc is used in the sense of comparison, that is, "like".

शिंबलं चित् वि वृश्चति (*śiṃbalaṃ cit vi vṛścati*): as the blossom of the Śālmalī tree drops off effortlessly at a mere breath of wind, so may the limbs of him who hates us, hands and the rest, be cut off and go to pieces.

इंद्र प्रयस्ता येषंती उखा चित् फेनं अस्यति (*iṃdra prayastā yeṣaṃtī ukhā cit phenaṃ asyati*): O Indra, as a pot, when struck, breaks and the water in it leaks out, so may our enemy, struck down by the power of our mantra, pour foam from his mouth; that is, the meaning is, may he die.

शिंबलं चित् वि वृश्चति (*śiṃbalaṃ cit vi vṛścati*): as the flower of the Śalmalī tree easily falls off, so may the enemy who hates us fall to the ground. May his limbs be cut off.

इंद्र प्रयस्ता येषंती उखा चित् फेनं अस्यति (*iṃdra prayastā yeṣaṃtī ukhā cit phenaṃ asyati*): as a broken, cracked pot, struck, leaks, so may our enemy, struck down by the power of our mantra, pour foam from his mouth.

Ṛk 23

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

न साय॑कस्य चिकिते जनासो लो॒धं न॑यन्ति॒ पशु॒ मन्य॑मानाः ।
नावा॑जिनं वा॒जिना॑ हासयन्ति॒ न ग॑र्द॒भं पु॒रो अश्वा॑न्न यन्ति ॥ २३ ॥

> *na sāyakasya cikite janāso lodhaṃ nayanti paśu manyamānāḥ |*
> *nāvājinaṃ vājinā hāsayanti na gardabhaṃ puro aśvānnayanti ‖ 23 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> न । सायकस्य । चिकिते । जनासः । लोधं । नयंति । पशु । मन्यमानाः ।
> न । अवाजिनं । वाजिना । हासयंति । न । गर्दभं ' पुरः । अश्वात् । नयंति ॥ २३ ॥

> *na | sāyakasya | cikite | janāsaḥ | lodhaṃ | nayaṃti | paśu | manyamānāḥ |*
> *na | avājinaṃ | vājinā | hāsayaṃti | na | gardabhaṃ ' puraḥ | aśvāt | nayaṃti ‖ 23 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पुरा खलु तपसः क्षयो मा प्रापदिति शापान्निवृत्तं मौनिनं विश्वामित्रं वसिष्ठपुरुषा बद्ध्वानीतवंतः । तान्प्रति विश्वामित्रो ब्रूते । हे जनासो जनाः सायकस्यावसानकारिणो विश्वामित्रस्य मंत्रगणसामर्थ्यं न चिकिते ' भविदिर्न ज्ञायते । अत एव लोधं लुब्धं तपसः क्षयो मा भूदिति लोभेन तूष्णीं स्थितमृषिं पशु मन्यमानाः । पशु इति निपातः पशुशब्दसमानार्थः । पशुवन्मन्यमाना एते नयंति । बद्ध्वा स्वकीयं देशं प्रापयंति । एवं स्वसामर्थ्यं प्रदर्श्य विसदृशो वसिष्टो मया सह स्पर्धितुं नार्हतीति धिक्करोति। नावाजिनमिति। अवाजिनं। वाचामिनो वाजिनः सर्वज्ञः । तद्विलक्षणं मूर्खजनं वाजिना वागीशा न हासयंति हास्यास्पदं न कुर्वंति । तेन सह न स्पर्धंत इत्यर्थः । तथा गर्दभं रासभमश्वात्पुरः पुरुस्तान्न नयंति । एवमेव विसदृशो वसिष्टो न मया स्पर्धितुमीष्ट इत्यर्थः ॥

> *purā khalu tapasaḥ kṣayo mā prāpaditi śāpānnivṛttaṃ mauninaṃ viśvāmitraṃ*
> *vasiṣṭhapuruṣā baddhvānītavaṃtaḥ | tānprati viśvāmitro brūte | he janāso janāḥ*
> *sāyakasyāvasānakāriṇo viśvāmitrasya maṃtragaṇasāmarthyaṃ na cikite ' bhavidirna jñāyate | ata eva lodhaṃ lubdhaṃ tapasaḥ kṣayo mā bhūditi lobhena tūṣṇīṃ sthitamṛṣiṃ*
> *paśu manyamānāḥ | paśu iti nipātaḥ paśuśabdasamānārthaḥ | paśuvanmanyamānā ete*
> *nayaṃti | baddhvā svakīyaṃ deśaṃ prāpayaṃti | evaṃ svasāmarthyaṃ pradarśya visadṛśo*
> *vasiṣṭo mayā saha spardhituṃ nārhatīti dhikkaroti| nāvājinamiti| avājinaṃ| vācāmino vājinaḥ sarvajñaḥ | tadvilakṣaṇaṃ mūrkhajanaṃ vājinā vāgīśā na hāsayaṃti hāsyāspadaṃ*
> *na kurvaṃti | tena saha na spardhaṃta ityarthaḥ | tathā gardabhaṃ rāsabhamaśvātpuraḥ purustānna*
> *nayaṃti | evameva visadṛśo vasiṣṭo na mayā spardhitumīṣṭa ityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

Formerly, when Viśvāmitra, silent and withdrawn from cursing lest his austerity be lost, was bound and brought by Vasiṣṭha's men, he addresses them. O people (जनासः (*janāsaḥ*)), the power of the group of mantras of Viśvāmitra, the "finisher" (सायकस्य (*sāyakasya*)), is not known (न चिकिते (*na cikite*)). Therefore they, regarding as a beast (पशु (*paśu*); पशु (*paśu*) is a particle equal in sense to the word पशु (*paśu*)) the greedy (लोधं (*lodhaṃ*)) seer who stayed silent from the greed that his austerity not be lost, lead (नयंति (*nayaṃti*)) him, that is, bind him and bring him to their own place. Thus, displaying his own power, he rebukes: Vasiṣṭha, unlike me, is not fit to compete with me. नावाजिनं (*nāvājinaṃ*): the अवाजिनं (*avājinaṃ*) is a foolish person, unlike the वाजिनः (*vājinaḥ*), the all-knowing master of speech; the masters of speech (वाजिना (*vājinā*)) do not make him a laughing-stock, that is, they do not compete with him. Likewise they do not lead (न नयंति (*na nayaṃti*)) an ass (गर्दभं (*gardabhaṃ*)) in front of a horse. Just so, the unlike Vasiṣṭha is not able to compete with me.

Word-to-word meaning

- जनासः (*janāsaḥ*)—O people
- सायकस्य (*sāyakasya*)—of the destroying (Viśvāmitra's) power of mantra
- न चिकिते (*na cikite*)—you are unable to know
- लोधं (*lodhaṃ*)—the seer who has taken refuge in silence
- पशु (*paśu*)—like an animal
- मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*)—these men, having taken (him) to be
- नयंति (*nayaṃti*)—are carrying (the seer) off to their own place
- आवाजिनं (*āvājinaṃ*)—the unwise man
- वाजिना (*vājinā*)—the learned
- न हासयंति (*na hāsayaṃti*)—do not hold up to ridicule
- गर्दभं (*gardabhaṃ*)—the ass
- अश्वात् पुरः (*aśvāt puraḥ*)—in front of the excellent horse
- न नयंति (*na nayaṃti*)—do not bring and set (it)

Gist

O people, you are unable to know the destroying power of Viśvāmitra's mantras. These men, having taken the seer, who had taken refuge in silence so that his austerity should not be wasted, to be like an animal, are carrying the seer off to their own place. The learned do not ridicule an unwise man. Nor do they put an ass in front of an excellent horse.

English translation

Men, (the might) of the destroyer is not known to you : regarding him as a mere animal, they lead him away desirous (silently to complete his devotions) : the wise condescend not to turn the foolish into ridicule, they do not lead the ass before the horse.

Special Topics

Viśvāmitra of old, lest the power of his austerity be wasted, observed a vow of silence and spoke to no one. For that very reason he kept quiet even towards his enemies, giving no curses and the like. Seeing this, the people on Vasiṣṭha's side took this Viśvāmitra to be like an animal that knows nothing, bound him tightly with ropes and went off carrying him. At that time Viśvāmitra speaks to those people in this manner—

जनासः सायकस्य न चिकिते लोधं पशुं मन्यमानः नयंति (*janāsaḥ sāyakasya na cikite lodhaṃ paśuṃ manyamānaḥ nayaṃti*)—हे जनात अवसानकारिणो विश्वामित्रस्य मंत्रगणसामर्थ्यं भवद्भिर्न ज्ञायते । आत एव तपसु क्षयोमा भूदति तूष्णीं स्थितमृषिं पशुवत् मन्यमानः बध्वा स्वकीयं देशं प्रापयंति । (*he janāta avasānakāriṇo viśvāmitrasya maṃtragaṇasāmarthyaṃ bhavadbhirna jñāyate | āta eva tapasu kṣayomā bhūdati tūṣṇīṃ sthitamṛṣiṃ paśuvat manyamānaḥ badhvā svakīyaṃ deśaṃ prāpayaṃti |*). These people, knowing the power of the mantras of this seer Viśvāmitra, whom they intend to kill, and taking this seer—who for that very reason keeps silent and quiet, not speaking, out of fear that his austerity will be destroyed—to be an animal, bind him with a rope and are carrying him off to their own country.

अवाजिनं—वाचां इनः स्वामी सर्वज्ञः । तद्विलक्षणं मूर्खजनं अवाजिनं (*avājinaṃ—vācāṃ inaḥ svāmī sarvajñaḥ | tadvilakṣaṇaṃ mūrkhajanaṃ avājinaṃ*). One who is lord of speech is called vājī; he is all-knowing. One who is the opposite of that is called avājī. Hence avājinam (accusative singular) means "a foolish man", such is the intention.

अवाजिनं वाजिना न हासयंति । गर्दभं अश्वात्पुरतः न नयंति (*avājinaṃ vājinā na hāsayaṃti | gardabhaṃ aśvātpurataḥ na nayaṃti*)—Good men who have the power of speech, being all-knowing, do not laugh at and ridicule foolish people who know nothing. For does one bring an ass and make it stand before an excellent horse? No. That is: these Vasiṣṭhas and the rest are foolish people without power of speech and without power of mantra. Such people do not wish to compete with me, who am all-knowing through the power of mantra. That is why, with the intention of doing me harm by force, they have bound me with a rope and are carrying me off to their own country.

Ṛk 24

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒म इ॑न्द्र भर॒तस्य॑ पु॒त्रा अ॑पपि॒त्वं चि॑कितु॒र्न प्र॑पि॒त्वम् ।
हि॒न्वन्त्यश्व॒मर॑णं॒ न नित्यं॒ ज्यावा॑जं॒ परि॑ णयन्त्या॒जौ ॥ २४ ॥

> *ima indra bharatasya putrā apapitvaṃ cikiturna prapitvam |*
> *hinvantyaśvamaraṇaṃ na nityaṃ jyāvājaṃ pari ṇayantyājau ‖ 24 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमे । इंद्र । भरतस्य । पुत्राः । अपपित्वं । चिकितुः । न । प्रपित्वं ।
> हिन्वंत । अश्वं । अरणं । न । नित्यं । ज्यावाजं । परि । नयंति । आजौ ॥ २४ ॥

> *ime | iṃdra | bharatasya | putrāḥ | apapitvaṃ | cikituḥ | na | prapitvaṃ |*
> *hinvaṃta | aśvaṃ | araṇaṃ | na | nityaṃ | jyāvājaṃ | pari | nayaṃti | ājau ‖ 24 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र भरतस्य पुत्रा भरतवंश्या इमे विश्वामित्रा अपपित्वमपगमनं वसिष्ठेभ्यश्चिकितुः । जानंति । प्रपित्वं प्रगमनं न जानंति । शिष्टैः सह तेषां संगतिर्नास्ति । ब्राह्मणा एव त इत्यर्थः । अपि चाजौ संग्रामे नित्यं सहजमरणं नारिमिव वसिष्ठान्प्रत्यशं हिन्वंति । प्रेरयंति । ततश्च ज्यावाजं बलं धनुः परि णयंति । वसिष्ठान्हंतुं शरसंधानेन चरंति ॥

> *he iṃdra bharatasya putrā bharatavaṃśyā ime viśvāmitrā apapitvamapagamanaṃ vasiṣṭhebhyaścikituḥ | jānaṃti | prapitvaṃ pragamanaṃ na jānaṃti | śiṣṭhaiḥ saha teṣāṃ saṃgatirnāsti | brāhmaṇā eva ta ityarthaḥ | api cājau saṃgrāme nityaṃ sahajamaraṇaṃ nārimiva*

> *vasiṣṭhānpratyaśaṃ hinvaṃti | prerayaṃti | tataśca jyāvājaṃ balaṃ dhanuḥ pari ṇayaṃti |*
> *vasiṣṭhānhaṃtuṃ śarasaṃdhānena caraṃti ‖*

Summary

O Indra, these sons of Bharata, the Viśvāmitras of Bharata's line, know अपपित्वं (*apapitvaṃ*), "going away" from the Vasiṣṭhas; they do not know प्रपित्वं (*prapitvaṃ*), "going towards". They have no association with the good (śiṣṭa); that is, those men are Brahmins indeed. Moreover, in battle they urge their horses against the Vasiṣṭhas as against an inborn, constant foe. Then they परि णयंति (*pari ṇayaṃti*) the bowstring-strong bow, going about fitting arrows in order to kill the Vasiṣṭhas.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- भरतस्य (*bharatasya*)—of the emperor Bharata
- पुत्राः (*putrāḥ*)—born of his line
- इमे (*ime*)—these Viśvāmitras and others
- अपपित्वं (*apapitvaṃ*)—as being different from the offspring of Vasiṣṭha
- चिकितुः (*cikituḥ*)—they know
- प्रपित्वं (*prapitvaṃ*)—that the two are related
- न (*na*)—they do not know
- आजौ (*ājau*)—in battle
- नित्यं (*nityaṃ*)—inborn
- अरणं न (*araṇaṃ na*)—like enemies
- अश्वं (*aśvaṃ*)—horses
- हिन्वंति (*hinvaṃti*)—drive forward against (the offspring of Vasiṣṭha) and confront (them)
- ज्यावाजं (*jyāvājaṃ*)—their powerful bow
- परिणयंति (*pariṇayaṃti*)—hold, fitting arrows

Gist

O Indra, these Viśvāmitras, born of the line of the emperor Bharata, take themselves to be different from the offspring of Vasiṣṭha. They do not know that the two are related. Regarding them as their inborn enemies in battle, they drive their horses against them and confront them. They raise their powerful bows against them, fitting arrows.

English translation

These sons of Bharata, Indra, understand severance (from the Vasisthas), not association (with them) ; they urge their steeds (agaist them) as against a constant foe ; they bear a stout bow (for their destruction) in battle.

Special Topics

The word prapitva (prapitve) has been read by Yāska among the "dviśa" names (Ni. 3-20)[?97]. And he gives the explanation: प्रपित्वेऽभीक इत्यासन्नस्य । प्रपित्वे प्राप्ते । अभीकेऽभक्ते। आपित्वे नः प्रपित्वे तूयमागहि कण्वेषु सु सचा पिब (ऋ. सं. ८-४-३) इत्यपि निगम् भवतः ॥ (*prapitve 'bhīka ityāsannasya* | *prapitve prāpte* | *abhīke 'bhakte* | *āpitve naḥ prapitve tūyamāgahi kaṇveṣu su sacā piba (ṛ. saṃ. 8-4-3) ityapi nigam bhavataḥ* ‖). Saying that prapitva means being near, being in the vicinity, close relationship, he has recited as an example the Ṛk beginning आपित्वे नः प्रपित्वे तूयमागहि कण्वेषु सु सचा पिब (*āpitve naḥ prapitve tūyamāgahi kaṇveṣu su sacā piba*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-4-3).

इंद्र भरतस्य इमे पुत्राः अपपित्वं चिकितुः न प्रपित्वं (*iṃdra bharatasya ime putrāḥ apapitvaṃ cikituḥ na prapitvaṃ*)—भरतवंश्या इमे विश्वामित्रादयः वसिष्ठेभ्यः अपगमनं जानंति प्रगमनं न जानंति । (*bharatavaṃśyā ime viśvāmitrādayaḥ vasiṣṭhebhyaḥ apagamanaṃ jānaṃti pragamanaṃ na jānaṃti* |). O Indra, the sons of Bharata, that is, Viśvāmitra and the others born of Bharata's line, regard these Vasiṣṭhas and the rest as born elsewhere, that is, as outsiders (or opponents, enemies). They regard it that there is no association with the Vasiṣṭhas, that is, no dealings and the like, and that there is no contact or friendship with the good men who are disciples of Vasiṣṭha and the rest. For there is mutual hostility between the descendants of Viśvāmitra and those of Vasiṣṭha.

आजौ नित्यं अरणं न अश्वं हिन्वंति, ज्यावाजं परिनयंति (*ājau nityaṃ araṇaṃ na aśvaṃ hinvaṃti, jyāvājaṃ parinayaṃti*)—For that very reason, in battle the people of Bharata's line, that is, Viśvāmitra and the others, regarding the Vasiṣṭhas as their inborn enemies, charge their horses upon them in order to confront them. And in order to kill the descendants of Vasiṣṭha they string their bows, set arrows and take aim. Such is the main intention.

This is the …-fourth sūkta.[?98]

Sūkta 54 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> पंचमेऽनुवाके नव सूक्तानि । तत्रेमं मह इति द्वाविंशत्यृचं प्रथमं
> सूक्तं त्रैष्टुभं वैश्वदेवं विश्वामित्रपुत्रस्य वाक्पुत्रस्य वा प्रजापतेरार्षं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । इमं
> महे द्वधिकोक्तगोत्रः प्रजापतिर्हि वैश्वदेवं हेति ।
> अस्मिन् सूक्त आद्याग्नेया ततः परं सप्तर्चो द्यावापृथिव्यास्ततः परा द्युदेवताका
> दशमी द्यावापृथिवैकादशी सावित्रि ततः परं सुकृदिति त्वाष्ट्रा र्भवी च विद्युद्रथेति मारुती
> सारस्वती च ततः परं तिस्रो विष्ट्हिंद्राग्नि देवताकाः स्वदस्वेत्याग्नीयाति।
> एवं वैश्वदेवं सूक्तं ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः । अग्निप्रणयने राजन्यस्येमं
> मह इति प्रतिपत् । पंचम्यां पौर्णमास्यामित्यत्र सूत्रितं । इमं महे विदथ्याय
> शूषं । आ. २–१७ । इति ॥

> *paṃcame 'nuvāke nava sūktāni | tatremaṃ maha iti dvāviṃśatyṛcaṃ prathamaṃ*
> *sūktaṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ vaiśvadevaṃ viśvāmitraputrasya vākputrasya vā prajāpaterārṣaṃ | atreyamanukramaṇikā | imaṃ mahe*
> *dvadhikoktagotraḥ prajāpatirhi vaiśvadevaṃ heti |*
> *asmin sūkta ādyāgneyā tataḥ paraṃ saptarco dyāvāpṛthivyāstataḥ parā dyudevatākā*
> *daśamī dyāvāpṛthivaikādaśī sāvitri tataḥ paraṃ sukṛditi tvāṣṭrā rbhavī ca vidyudratheti mārutī sārasvatī ca tataḥ paraṃ tisro viṣṭhiṃdrāgni devatākāḥ svadasvetyāgnīyāti|*
> *evaṃ vaiśvadevaṃ sūktaṃ ‖ sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ | agnipraṇayane rājanyasyèmaṃ*
> *maha iti pratipat | paṃcamyāṃ paurṇamāsyāmityatra sūtritaṃ | imaṃ mahe vidathyāya*
> *śūṣaṃ | ā. 2-17 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the fifth anuvāka there are nine sūktas. The first of them, इमं महे (*imaṃ mahe*), has twenty-two Ṛks; it is in Triṣṭubh, addressed to the Viśvedevas, and its seer is Prajāpati, son of Viśvāmitra or son of Vāc. Sāyaṇa cites the Anukramaṇikā: इमं महे द्वधिकोक्तगोत्रः प्रजापतिर्हि वैश्वदेवं हे (*imaṃ mahe dvadhikoktagotraḥ prajāpatirhi vaiśvadevaṃ he*). In this sūkta the first Ṛk is addressed to Agni; the seven after it to Heaven and Earth (Dyāvāpṛthivī); the next one to Dyu; the tenth to Heaven and Earth; the eleventh to Savitṛ; then the Ṛk सुकृत् (*sukṛt*) to Tvaṣṭṛ and the Ṛbhus; विद्युद्रथा (*vidyudrathā*) to the Maruts and Sarasvatī; the next three to Viṣṇu, Indra and Agni[?99]; and स्वदस्व (*svadasva*), the last, to Agni. Thus the sūkta is Vaiśvadeva. The use of the sūkta is by indication (laiṅgika): in the Agnipraṇayana, the Ṛk इमं महे (*imaṃ mahe*) is the opening verse (pratipad) for a Rājanya, as stated in the sūtra on the fifth-day full moon: इमं महे विदथ्याय शूषं (*imaṃ mahe vidathyāya śūṣaṃ*) (Ā. Sū. 2-17).

> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त——५४
> मंडल——३ ॥ अनुवाक——५ ॥ सूक्त——५४ ॥
> अष्टक——३ ॥ अध्याय——३ ॥ वर्ग——२४, २५, २६, २७ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये——२२ ॥
> ऋषिः——प्रजापतिर्वैश्वामित्रो वाच्यो वा ॥
> देवता——विश्वेदेवाः ॥
> छंदः——त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—54*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—5 ‖ sūkta—54 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—3 ‖ varga—24, 25, 26, 27 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—22 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—prajāpatirvaiśvāmitro vācyo vā ‖*
> *devatā—viśvedevāḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मं म॒हे वि॑द॒थ्या॑य शू॒षं श॒श्व॑त्कृ॒त्व ईड्या॑य॒ प्र ज॑भ्रुः ।
शृ॒णोतु॑ नो॒ दम्ये॑भि॒रनी॑कैः शृ॒णोत्व॒ग्निर्दि॒व्यैरज॑स्रः ॥ १ ॥

> *imaṃ mahe vidathyāya śūṣaṃ śaśvatkṛtva īḍyāya pra jabhruḥ |*
> *śṛṇotu no damyebhiranīkaiḥ śṛṇotvagnirdivyairajasraḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमं । महे । विदथ्याय । शूषं । शश्वत् । कृत्वः । ईड्याय । प्र । जभ्रुः ।
> शृणोतु । नः । दम्येभिः । अनीकैः । शृणोतु । अग्निः । दिव्यैः । अदस्रः ॥ १ ॥

> *imaṃ | mahe | vidathyāya | śūṣaṃ | śaśvat | kṛtvaḥ | īḍyāya | pra | jabhruḥ |*
> *śṛṇotu | naḥ | damyebhiḥ | anīkaiḥ | śṛṇotu | agniḥ | divyaiḥ | adasraḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> महे महते विदथ्याय विदथे यज्ञे मंथनेन निष्पाद्यमानायेड्र्याय
> सर्वैः स्तुत्यायाग्नये शूषं सुखकरमिमं स्तोमं शश्वत्कृत्वो भूयो भूयः
> प्र जभ्रुः । प्रभरंति । प्रकर्षण धारयंति । उच्चारयंतीत्यर्थः । सोग्निर्दम्येभिः
> परेषां दमनकुशलैर्दमे गृहे विद्यमानैर्वानीकैस्तेजोभिर्युक्तः सन् नोस्मदीयमिमं स्तोमं शृणोतु।
> दिव्यैर्दिवि भव्यैस्तेजोभिरजस्रो निरंतरं युक्तोऽग्निरिमं स्तोमं शृणोतु। शश्वत्कृत्व ईड्याय प्र
> जभ्रुरिति स्वानामेवैनं तच्छ्रष्ट्यं
> गमयति । ऐ. ब्रा. १–२८ । इति ब्राह्मणानुसारेण महदादिगुणविशिष्टाय यजमानायेममग्निं
> प्रजभ्रुः प्रहरंत्यृत्विज इति वा व्याख्येयं। उत्तरार्धर्चः समान एव॥
> विदथ्याय । तत्र भव इत्यर्थे भवे छंदसीति यत् । तित्स्वरितः । ईड्याय । ईडवंदेः–

> *mahe mahate vidathyāya vidathe yajñe maṃthanena*
> *niṣpādyamānāyeḍryāya*
> *sarvaiḥ stutyāyāgnaye śūṣaṃ sukhakaramimaṃ stomaṃ śaśvatkṛtvo*

> *bhūyo bhūyaḥ*
> *pra jabhruḥ | prabharaṃti | prakarṣaṇa dhārayaṃti |*
> *uccārayaṃtītyarthaḥ | sognirdamyebhiḥ*
> *pareṣāṃ damanakuśalairdame gṛhe vidyamānairvānīkaistejobhiryuktaḥ*
> *san nosmadīyamimaṃ stomaṃ śṛṇotu| divyairdivi*
> *bhavyaistejobhirajasro niraṃtaraṃ yukto 'gnirimaṃ stomaṃ śṛṇotu|*
> *śaśvatkṛtva īḍyāya pra jabhruriti svānāmevainaṃ tacchṛṣṭyaṃ*
> *gamayati | ai. brā. 1-28 | iti brāhmaṇānusāreṇa mahadādiguṇaviśiṣṭāya*
> *yajamānāyemamagniṃ prajabhruḥ praharaṃtyṛtvija iti vā vyākhyeyaṃ|*
> *uttarārdharcaḥ samāna eva‖*
> *vidathyāya | tatra bhava ityarthe bhave chaṃdasīti yat | titsvaritaḥ |*
> *īḍyāya | īḍavaṃdè:-*

> त्यादिना उदात्तत्वं । दम्येभिः । तत्र साधुरिति यत् । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> दिव्यैः । दिवमर्हतीत्यर्थे छंदसि चेति यप्रत्ययः । अजस्रः । जसु मोक्षणे । नमिकंपीत्यादिना
> ताच्छिलिको रप्रत्ययः । नञ्जा समासे तस्य स्वरः ॥

> *tyādinā udāttatvaṃ | damyebhiḥ | tatra sādhuriti yat | yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ |*
> *divyaiḥ | divamarhatītyarthe chaṃdasi ceti yapratyayaḥ | ajasraḥ | jasu mokṣaṇe | namikaṃpītyādinā tācchiliko rapratyayaḥ | nañjā samāse tasya svaraḥ ‖*

Summary

To the great (महे (*mahe*)) विदथ्याय (*vidathyāya*)—vidatha being the sacrifice—that is, to Agni, who is produced in the sacrifice by churning and is ईड्याय (*īḍyāya*), to be praised by all, they bring forth (प्र जभ्रुः (*pra jabhruḥ*): they bear forward, hold up, utter) again and again (शश्वत्कृत्वः (*śaśvatkṛtvaḥ*)) this pleasing (शूषं (*śūṣaṃ*)) hymn. May that Agni, endowed with दम्येभिः (*damyebhiḥ*) radiances—skilled in subduing others, or present in the house (dama)—hear this hymn of ours. May Agni, constantly endowed with divine radiances, hear it. The second half of the verse is the same. Alternatively, following the Brāhmaṇa शश्वत्कृत्व ईड्याय प्र जभ्रुरिति स्वानामेवैनं तच्छृष्ट्यं गमयति । (*śaśvatkṛtva īḍyāya pra jabhruriti svānāmevainaṃ tacchṛṣṭyaṃ gamayati* |) (Ai. Brā. 1-28), it is to be explained that the officiants bring forth this Agni for the sacrificer, who is endowed with greatness and other qualities.

The rest of the block gives the accent and derivation of the words दम्येभिः (*damyebhiḥ*), दिव्यैः (*divyaiḥ*) and अजस्रः (*ajasraḥ*) (with ईड्याय (*īḍyāya*) at its beginning): दम्येभिः (*damyebhiḥ*) in the sense "good in that", दिव्यैः (*divyaiḥ*) in the sense "worthy of heaven", अजस्रः (*ajasraḥ*) from the root जसु (*jasu*) in the sense of release, with the negative compound.

Word-to-word meaning

- महे (*mahe*)—who is of great nature
- विदथ्याय (*vidathyāya*)—who is born for the sacrifice
- ईड्याय (*īḍyāya*)—who is worthy of praise: addressing Agni
- शूषं (*śūṣaṃ*)—pleasing
- इमं (*imaṃ*)—this
- स्तोमवन्नु (*stomavannu*)—hymn
- शश्वत्कृत्वः (*śaśvatkṛtvaḥ*)—again and again
- प्र जभ्रुः (*pra jabhruḥ*)—they offer
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni, the great one
- दम्येभिः (*damyebhiḥ*)—that subdue enemies
- अनीकैः (*anīkaiḥ*)—endowed with radiances
- नः (*naḥ*)—this hymn of ours
- श्रृणोतु (*śṛṇotu*)—may he hear
- दिव्यैः (*divyaiḥ*)—endowed with divine radiances
- अजस्रः (*ajasraḥ*)—always
- श्रृणोतु (*śṛṇotu*)—may he hear

Gist

To Agni, who is of great nature, who is born for the sacrifice, who is worthy of praise, they offer this hymn, which is praising and pleasing. May Agni, the great one, endowed with radiances that subdue enemies, hear this hymn of ours. May Agni, endowed with divine radiances, always hear.

English translation

They recite repeatedly this gratifying praise to the great product of sacrifice (Agni) : may he who (is endowed) with domestic radiance hear us : may the imperishable Agni, (endowed) with divine radiance, hear us.

Special Topics

महे विदथ्याय प्र जभ्रुः (*mahe vidathyāya pra jabhruḥ*)—Sāyaṇa has explained two kinds of meaning: महते यज्ञे मंथनेन निष्पाद्यमानाय सर्वैः स्तुत्याय अग्नये । (*mahate yajñè maṃthanena niṣpādyamānāya sarvaiḥ stutyāya agnaye* |); and महदादिगुणविशिष्टाय यजमानाय (*mahadādiguṇaviśiṣṭāya yajamānāya*). The first meaning indicates the greatness of Agni. The word vidatha is read by Yāska (Ni. 3-19) among the names of sacrifice. From this the meaning is explained thus: Agni, being produced in the sacrificial rite in his own abode by being churned from the araṇis, is praised by all, and for this Agni the officiants recite hymns many times. In the second meaning, in accordance with the sentence of the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa “शश्वत्पृत्व ईड्याय प्रजभ्रुरिति स्थानामेवैनं तच्छैष्यं गमयति । (*śaśvatpṛtva īḍyāya prajabhruriti sthānāmevainaṃ tacchaiṣyaṃ gamayati* |)” (Ai. Brā. 1-28)[?100], it is explained that the officiants have praised Agni many times for the sacrificer, who is endowed with qualities such as worthiness of honour. For a detailed explanation of this, see Ṛ. Saṃ. part 14, page 53

The meaning of the word ईड्याय (*īḍyāya*) is explained in a way that relates it to both Agni and the sacrificer.

शूषं-सुखकरं । (*śūṣaṃ-sukhakaraṃ* |) The word शूष (*śūṣa*) is listed (Ni. 3-13) among the names of happiness. Here it is used in the sense "bringing happiness".

दम्येभिः—परेषां दमनकुशलैः । गृहे विद्यमानैर्वा । (*damyebhiḥ—pareṣāṃ damanakuśalaiḥ* | *gṛhe vidyamānairvā* |) The word दम (*dama*) is read (Ni. 4-4) among the names of the house. Here the word is used as an adjective of a word that denotes brilliance (tejas). Two meanings are therefore explained: the brilliances of Agni are capable of subduing enemies, or they shine on the altar of the sacrificial hall.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

महि॑ म॒हे दि॒वे अ॑र्चा पृथि॒व्यै कामो॑ म इ॒च्छञ्च॑र
ति प्रजा॒नन् ।
ययो॑र्ह॒ स्तोमे॑ वि॒दथे॑षु दे॒वाः स॑प॒र्यवो॑ मा॒दय॑न्ते॒ स
चा॒योः ॥ २ ॥

> *mahi mahe dive arcā pṛthivyai kāmo ma icchañcarati prajānan |*
> *yayorha stome vidatheṣu devāḥ saparyavo mādayante sacāyoḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महि । महे । दिवे । अर्च । पृथिव्यै । कामः । मे । इच्छन् । चरति । प्रजानन् ।
> ययोः । ह । स्तोमे । विदथेषु । देवाः । सपर्यवः । मादयंते । सचा ।
> आयोः ॥ २ ॥

> *mahi | mahe | dive | arca | pṛthivyai | kāmaḥ | me | icchan | carati | prajānan |*
> *yayoḥ | ha | stome | vidatheṣu | devāḥ | saparyavaḥ | mādayaṃte | sacā |*
> *āyoḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे स्तोतर्महे महत्यै दिने द्युलोकदेवताय्के महत्यै पृथिव्यै च महि
> महत् त्वं प्रजानन् स्तोत्रमर्च । कुरु । मे मम कामो मनोरथः सर्वान्
> भोगानिच्छन् चरति । सर्वत्र वर्तते । आयोर्मनुष्यस्य विदथेषु यज्ञेषु
> ययोर्दानापृथिव्योः स्तोमे स्तोत्रे सपर्यवः पूजाकामा देवाः स्तोतारो
> वा सचा मादयंते ह सह माद्यंति खलु ॥ पृथिव्यै । उदात्तयण इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ।
> सपर्यवः । सपर्यामिच्छतीत्यर्थे सुपः क्यच् ॥

> *he stotarmahe mahatyai dine dyulokadevatāykè mahatyai pṛthivyai ca mahi*
> *mahat tvaṃ prajānan stotramarca | kuru | me mama kāmo manorathaḥ sarvān*

> *bhogānicchan carati | sarvatra vartate | āyormanuṣyasya vidatheṣu yajñeṣu*
> *yayordānāpṛthivyoḥ stome stotre saparyavaḥ pūjākāmā devāḥ stotāro vā sacā mādayaṃte ha saha mādyaṃti khalu ‖ pṛthivyai | udāttayaṇa iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | saparyavaḥ | saparyāmicchatītyarthe supaḥ kyac ‖*

Summary

"O worshipper, to the great (महे (*mahe*)) day, that is, to the deity of the heavenly world, and to the great earth, offer praise (अर्च (*arca*)), knowing (प्रजानन् (*prajānan*)) their greatness (महि (*mahi*))." My desire (कामः (*kāmaḥ*)), wishing for all enjoyments, ranges (चरति (*carati*)) everywhere. In the sacrifices (विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*)) of the man (आयोः (*āyoḥ*)), in the praise (स्तोमे (*stome*)) of those two, heaven and earth, the gods (देवाः (*devāḥ*)), desirous of worship (सपर्यवः (*saparyavaḥ*)), or else the worshippers, rejoice (मादयंते (*mādayaṃte*)) together (सचा (*sacā*)); they do indeed rejoice together.

Word-to-word meaning

- महे (*mahe*)—(O worshipper,) to the one of great nature
- दिवे (*dive*)—to the presiding deity of heaven
- पृथिव्यै (*pṛthivyai*)—also to the presiding deity of the earth
- महि (*mahi*)—(their) greatness
- प्रजानन् (*prajānan*)—having known
- अर्च (*arca*)—offer worship
- मे (*me*)—my
- कामः (*kāmaḥ*)—desire
- इच्छन् (*icchan*)—wishing for all enjoyments
- चरति (*carati*)—moves about everywhere
- आयोः (*āyoḥ*)—of the man
- विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*)—in the sacrifices
- ययोः (*yayoḥ*)—of which same heaven and earth
- स्तोमे (*stome*)—at the time of praise
- सपरवः (*saparavaḥ*)—desirous of worship
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—the worshippers (or the gods)
- सचा (*sacā*)—gathering together

- मादयंते (*mādayaṃte*)—rejoice

Gist

O worshipper, knowing the greatness of the heavenly deity of great nature and of the earth deity, offer worship to them. At the time of praising these heaven and earth, the worshippers who desire to worship gather together and rejoice. My desire too moves everywhere, wishing for all enjoyments.

English translation

Knowing their greatness, offer worship to the vast heaven and to the earth : my desire, wishing (for felicity) proceeds (to them), in whose praise the gods, desirous of adoration, delight together with their worshippers at the sacrifice.

Special Topics

सपर्यवः देवाः सचा मादयंते— पूजाकामाः देवाः स्तोतारो वा सह माद्यंति खलु । (*saparyavaḥ devāḥ sacā mādayaṃte— pūjākāmāḥ devāḥ stotāro vā saha mādyaṃti khalu* |) In this Ṛk the greatness of heaven and earth is described. The word अयुः (*ayuḥ*) is listed (Ni. 3-8) among the names of man. For the word सपर्यवः (*saparyavaḥ*) Sāyaṇa gives two meanings: those who perform worship, and those who receive worship. The ṛtvijs of the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice are glad to recite hymns for the sacrificer, who is eager to obtain his various wishes. The gods too are glad to hear these hymns. Therefore the seer's injunction is described here: let the ṛtvijs, who know well the greatness of heaven and earth, who are worthy of worship, praise them. By this it is also said that the greatness of heaven and earth, who fulfil the sacrificer's wish, is unsurpassed.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यु॒वोरृ॒तं रो॑दसी स॒त्यम॑स्तु म॒हे षु ण॑◌ः सु॒वि॒ताय॒
प्र भू॑तम् ।
इ॒दं दि॒वे नमो॑ अग्ने पृथि॒व्यै सं॑प॒र्यामि॒ प्रय॑सा॒ या
मि॒ रत्न॑म् ॥ ३ ॥

> *yuvorṛtaṃ rodasī satyamastu mahe ṣu ṇaḥ suvitāya pra bhūtam |*
> *idaṃ dive namo agne pṛthivyai saparyāmi prayasā yāmi ratnam ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> युवोः । ऋतं । रोदसी इति । सत्यं । अस्तु । महे । सु । नः । सुविताय । प्र ।
> भूतं ।
> इदं । दिवे । नमः । आग्ने । पृथिव्यै । सपर्यामि । प्रयसा । यामि । रत्नं ॥ ३ ॥

> *yuvoḥ | ṛtaṃ | rodasī iti | satyaṃ | astu | mahe | su | naḥ | suvitāya |*
> *pra |*
> *bhūtaṃ |*
> *idaṃ | dive | namaḥ | āgne | pṛthivyai | saparyāmi | prayasā | yāmi |*
> *ratnaṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यौ युवोर्युवयोर्ऋतमानृशंस्यं सत्यं
> यथार्थमस्तु । युवां नोऽस्माकं महे महते सुवितायाभ्युदयायै यज्ञसमाप्त्यर्थं सु सुष्टु प्र भूतं ।
> प्रभवतं । हे अग्ने दिने पृथिव्यै चेदं नमोऽस्तु । प्रयसा हनिर्लक्षणेनान्नेन सपर्यामि परिचरामि ।
> रत्नमुत्तमं धनं यामि।
> याचे । यातिर्याच्ञा कर्मा ईमह इत्यादिषु पठितत्वात् ॥ षु । संहितायां सुइ
> इति षत्वं । णः । संहितायां नश्च धातुस्थोरुषभ्य इति णत्वं । सुविताय । इण् गत्।
> अधिकरणे क्तः। शोभनं गम्यतेऽस्मिन्निति सुवितं । उवजादेशश्छांदसः। भूतं । भवतेर्लोटि
> बहुलं छंदसीति शपो लुकि रूपं । यद्वा । छांदसे लुजि सिचो गातिस्थेति लुक् । निघातः ।
> दिवे पृथिव्यै । नमःस्वस्तीत्यादिना । पा। २–३–१६ । चतुर्थी ।
> सपर्यामि कंड्वादिः परिचरणे वर्तते । प्रत्ययस्वरः । यामि । यातेर्लट
> रूपं । वाक्यभेदादनिघातः ॥

> *he rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyau yuvoryuvayorṛtamānṛśaṃsyaṃ satyaṃ yathārthamastu | yuvāṃ no 'smākaṃ mahe mahate suvitāyābhyudayāyè yajñasamāptyarthaṃ su suṣṭu pra bhūtaṃ | prabhavataṃ | he agne dine pṛthivyai cedaṃ namo 'stu | prayasā hanirlakṣaṇenānnena saparyāmi paricarāmi | ratnamuttamaṃ dhanaṃ yāmi|*
> *yāce | yātiryāñjā karmā īmaha ityādiṣu paṭhitatvāt ‖ ṣu | saṃhitāyāṃ sui*
> *iti ṣatvaṃ | ṇaḥ | saṃhitāyāṃ naśca dhātusthoruṣabhya iti ṇatvaṃ | suvitāya | iṇ gat|*
> *adhikaraṇe ktaḥ| śobhanaṃ gamyate 'sminniti suvitaṃ | uvajādeśaśchāṃdasaḥ| bhūtaṃ | bhavaterloṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapo luki rūpaṃ | yadvā | chāṃdase luji sico gātistheti luk | nighātaḥ | dive pṛthivyai | namaḥsvastītyādinā | pā| 2-3-16 | caturthī |*
> *saparyāmi kaṃḍvādiḥ paricaraṇe vartate | pratyayasvaraḥ | yāmi | yāterlaṭa*
> *rūpaṃ | vākyabhedādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O heaven and earth (रोदसी (*rodasī*)), let your ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*), that is, freedom from cruelty (anṛśaṃsya), be true (सत्यं (*satyaṃ*)), that is, real. For our great (महे (*mahe*)) well-being (सुविताय (*suvitāya*)), that is, prosperity, and for the completion of the sacrifice, be fully (सु (*su*)) effective (प्र भूतं (*pra bhūtaṃ*)). O Agni, let this homage be to heaven and to earth. With oblation-food (प्रयसा (*prayasā*)) I serve them (सपर्यामि (*saparyāmi*), "I attend upon"). I ask (यामि (*yāmi*)) for excellent wealth (रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)); the root या (*yā*) has the sense of asking, since it is read among īmahe and the like. He adds that the verb सपर्यामि (*saparyāmi*) has the sense of attending upon, and that because of the break between sentences यामि (*yāmi*) is not accentless. He also gives the dative of दिवे पृथिव्यै (*dive pṛthivyai*) by the rule नमःस्वस्तीत्यादिना (*namaḥsvastītyādinā*) (Pā. Sū. 2-3-16). The alternative on the aorist of भूतं (*bhūtaṃ*) belongs to the grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—O heaven and earth
- युवोः (*yuvoḥ*)—of you two

- सत्यं (*satyaṃ*)—the nature that consists of truth
- यतं (*yataṃ*)—as unobstructed
- अस्तु (*astu*)—let it be eternal
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- महे (*mahe*)—great
- सुविताय (*suvitāya*)—for the completion of the sacrifice
- सु प्रभूतं (*su prabhūtaṃ*)—be gracious
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- दिवे (*dive*)—to the deity of heaven
- पृथिव्यै (*pṛthivyai*)—to the earth
- इदं नमः (*idaṃ namaḥ*)—this homage is offered
- प्रयसा (*prayasā*)—with food in the form of oblation
- सपर्यामि (*saparyāmi*)—I worship
- रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)—excellent wealth
- यामि (*yāmi*)—I ask for

Gist

O heaven and earth, let the true nature of you two be unobstructed and eternal; be gracious to us for the completion of our great sacrifice. O Agni, this my homage is offered to the deity of heaven and to the earth. I worship them with food in the form of oblation and ask for excellent wealth.

English translation

Heaven and earth, may your truth be ever inviolable : be propitious to us for the due completion of the rite : this adoration (Agni) is offered to heaven and earth : I worship (them) with (sacrificial) food ; I solicit of them precious (wealth).

Special Topics

यवोः ऋतं रोदसी सत्यमस्तु—हे द्यावापृथिव्यौ युवयोः अनृशंस्यं यथार्थमस्तु । (*yavoḥ ṛtaṃ rodasī satyamastu—he dyāvāpṛthivyau yuvayoḥ anṛśaṃsyaṃ yathārthamastu* |) Yāska (Ni. 4-19) uses the word ऋत (*ṛta*) in the senses "truth" or "sacrifice" and in other senses as well. Here the commentator explains the word ऋत (*ṛta*) as "being of generous mind" and gives the sense of a prayer: let heaven and earth be generous-minded towards the sacrificer. The sacrificer's prayer is thus indicated: let the nature of heaven and earth, in regard to the sacrificer, be, in accordance with the sense, excellent and forbearing.

In the second sentence the word सुविताय (*suvitāya*) is used in the sense शोभनं गम्यते अस्मिन् इति सुवितं (*śobhanaṃ gamyate asmin iti suvitaṃ*), "that from which welfare comes". Therefore सुविताय अभ्युदयाय यज्ञसमाप्त्यर्थं (*suvitāya abhyudayāya yajñasamāptyarthaṃ*): for the completion of the sacrifice of the sacrificer who brings about welfare, may heaven and earth be purposeful; thus the sacrificer's wish is described.[?101]

The word प्रयस् (*prayas*) is listed (Ni. 3-9) among the names of food. The sacrificer's wish is stated: that he will satisfy heaven and earth with food in the form of oblation, and, bowing to Agni and worshipping heaven and earth, will pray in order to obtain excellent wealth.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒तो हि वां॑ पू॒र्व्या आ॑विवि॒द्र ऋता॑वरी रोदसी सत्य॒वाच॑◌ः ।
नर॑श्चिद्वां समि॒थे शूर॑सातौ ववन्दि॒रे पृ॑थिवि॒ वेवि॑दानाः ॥ ४ ॥

> *uto hi vāṃ pūrvyā āvividra ṛtāvarī rodasī satyavācaḥ |*
> *naraścidvāṃ samithe śūrasātau vavandire pṛthivi vevidānāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उतो इति । हि । वां। पूर्व्याः । आविविद्रे । ऋतवरी इत्यृतवरी । रोदसी इति।
> सत्यवाचः ।
> नरः । चित् । वां । सम्इथे । शूरसातौ । ववंदिरे । प्रथिवि । वेविदानाः ॥ ४ ॥

> *uto iti | hi | vāṃ| pūrvyāḥ | āvividrè | ṛtavarī ityṛtavarī | rodasī iti|*
> *satyavācaḥ |*
> *naraḥ | cit | vāṃ | samithe | śūrasātau | vavaṃdire | prathivi |*
> *vevidānāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उतो अपि च हे ऋतावारी । ऋतं सत्यं । तद्वत्यौ हे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यौ पूर्वाः पूर्वे भवाः
> पुरातनाः सत्यवाचो महर्षयो नां युवाभ्यामाविविद्रे हि । तं तमपेक्षितमर्थं लेभिरे खलु । तथा
> हे पृथिवि शूरसात्
> शूराणां सातिर्लाभो यस्मिन् तस्मिन्नमिथे संगमननिमित्ते यद्वे नरश्चिदद्यतना
> मनुष्याश्च वां युवयोर्माहात्म्यं वेविदाना जानंतोऽतो द्यावापृथिव्यौ
> ववंदिरे । स्तुवंति ॥ अविविद्रे । विद्ल लाभे इत्ययमुभयपदी । लिट इरयो र
> इति रेआदेशः । सह सुपेत्यत्र सहेति योगविभागादाजा सह समासः । समिथे । इण्
> गत् । समाण इति थक्प्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *uto api ca he ṛtāvārī | ṛtaṃ satyaṃ | tadvatyau he rodasī*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyau pūrvāḥ pūrve bhavāḥ purātanāḥ satyavāco maharṣayo*
> *nāṃ yuvābhyāmāvividrè hi | taṃ tamapekṣitamarthaṃ lebhire khalu |*
> *tathā he pṛthivi śūrasāt*
> *śūrāṇāṃ sātirlābho yasmin tasminnamithe saṃgamananimitte yadde*
> *naraścidadyatanā*
> *manuṣyāśca vāṃ yuvayormāhātmyaṃ vevidānā jānaṃto 'to*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyau*
> *vavaṃdire | stuvaṃti ‖ avividrè | vidla lābhe ityayamubhayapadī | liṭa*
> *irayo ra*
> *iti reādeśaḥ | saha supetyatra saheti yogavibhāgādājā saha samāsaḥ |*
> *samithe | iṇ*
> *gat | samāṇa iti thakpratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

And further, O truthful (ऋतावरी (*ṛtāvarī*); ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*) is truth, and the two possess it) heaven and earth, the ancient seers who speak truth (सत्यवाचः (*satyavācaḥ*)), born of old, obtained (आविविद्रे (*āvividrè*)) from you each desired object; they did indeed obtain it. So too, O earth, in the battle (समिथे (*samithe*)), the occasion of meeting, in which there is the winning (sāti) of heroes (शूरसातौ (*śūrasātau*)), men of the present day also, knowing (वेविदानाः (*vevidānāḥ*)) the greatness of you two, praise (ववंदिरे (*vavaṃdire*)) heaven and earth. The remainder of the block gives the grammar of अविविद्रे (*avividrè*) and समिथे (*samithe*).

Word-to-word meaning

- उतो (*uto*)—and
- ऋतावरी (*ṛtāvarī*)—O truth-natured
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth
- पूर्वाः (*pūrvāḥ*)—the ancient
- सत्यवाचः (*satyavācaḥ*)—great seers who speak truth
- वां (*vāṃ*)—by your grace
- आ विविद्रे हि (*ā vividrè hi*)—obtained their desired objects
- पृथिवि (*pṛthivi*)—O earth
- शूरसात् (*śūrasāt*)—in which heroes fight
- समिधे (*samidhe*)—in battle
- नरश्चित् (*naraścit*)—all the men who fight
- वां (*vāṃ*)—your
- वेविदानाः (*vevidānāḥ*)—having known the greatness
- ववंदिरे (*vavaṃdire*)—praise (you)

Gist

O heaven and earth, of truthful nature, did not the ancient great seers, who speak truth, obtain their desired objects by your grace? O earth, in the battle in which heroes fight, all the men who are warriors, knowing your greatness, praise you.

English translation

Heaven and earth, endowed with truth, they who are the ancient declarers of the truth, have obtained from you (what they desired) ; and so, earth, men cognizant (of the greatness of you both) have worshipped you for the sake of triumphing over (hostile) heroes in battle.

Special Topics

The unsurpassed and abundant greatness of heaven and earth is described: they bring grace to the ancient great seers who speak truth, and bring welfare to the heroes who fight in battles.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

को अ॒द्धा वे॑द॒ क इ॒ह प्र वो॑चद्दे॒वाँ अच्छा॑ प॒थ्या॒
३॒॑ का समे॑ति ।
ददृ॑श्र एषामव॒मा सदां॑सि॒ परे॑षु॒ या गुह्ये॑षु व्र॒तेषु॑
॥ ५ ॥

> *ko addhā veda ka iha pra vocaddevā~ acchā pathyā kā sameti |*
> *dadṛśra eṣāmavamā sadāṃsi pareṣu yā guhyeṣu vrateṣu ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कः । अद्धा । वेद । कः । इह । प्र । वोचत् । देवान् । अच्छ । पथ्या । का । सम् ।
> ऐति ।
> ददृश्रे । एषां । अवमा । सदांसि । परेषु । या । गुह्येषु । व्रतेषु ॥ ५ ॥

> *kaḥ | addhā | veda | kaḥ | iha | pra | vocat | devān | accha | pathyā |*
> *kā | sam |*
> *aiti |*
> *dadṛśre | eṣāṃ | avamā | sadāṃsi | pareṣu | yā | guhyeṣu | vrateṣu ‖ 5*
> *‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> को वाद्धा सत्यभूतं तादृशमर्थं वेद । वेत्ति । को वेहास्मिन्प्रज्ञातमर्थं प्र वोचत् । प्र ब्रवीति ।
> किं तत्तदुच्यते । देवानच्छाभिलक्ष्य का पथ्या पथि
> साधुः समीचीनः को वा मार्गः समेति । सम्यक् प्राप्नोतीति । इममर्थं न कश्चिज्ञानाति । न
> कोऽपि ब्रवीति । किं ते देवा विद्यंते । वाढमित्याह । एषां दिवि स्थितानां नक्षत्ररूपाणां
> देवानामवमाधोमुखानि सदांसि स्थानानि ददृश्रे । दृश्यंते ।
> तथापि परेषूत्तमेषु गुह्येषु दुर्ज्ञानेषु व्रतेषु कर्मस्वनुष्ठतेषु या यानि

> *ko vāddā satyabhūtaṃ tādṛśamarthaṃ veda | vetti | ko vehāsminprajñātamarthaṃ pra vocat | pra bravīti | kiṃ tattaducyate | devānacchābhilakṣya kā pathyā pathi*
> *sādhuḥ samīcīnaḥ ko vā mārgaḥ sameti | samyak prāpnotīti | imamarthaṃ na kaścijñānāti | na ko 'pi bravīti | kiṃ te devā vidyaṃte | vāḍhamityāha | eṣāṃ divi sthitānāṃ nakṣatrarūpāṇāṃ devānāmavamādhomukhāni sadāṃsi sthānāni dadṛśre | dṛśyaṃte | tathāpi pareṣūttameṣu guhyeṣu durjñāneṣu vrateṣu karmasvanuṣṭhateṣu yā yāni*

> दिवि देवस्थानानि लभ्यंते तत्रागंतुं को मार्ग इति वेदमंतरेण न कश्चिज्ञानातीत्यभिप्रायः ॥ अद्धा । स्वरादिसंतोदात्तत्वेन पठितश्चादंतोदात्तः । वोचत् । ब्रूञ्
> व्यक्तायां वाचि लुजि ब्रुवो वचिरिति वच्यादेशः । अस्यतिवक्तिख्यातिभ्य इति चेरजादेशः । वच उमित्युमागमः । निघातः ॥

> *divi devasthānāni labhyaṃte tatrāgaṃtuṃ ko mārga iti vedamaṃtareṇa na kaścijñānātītyabhiprāyaḥ ‖ addhā | svarādisaṃtodāttatvena paṭhitaśvādaṃtodāttaḥ | vocat | brūñ*
> *vyaktāyāṃ vāci luji bruvo vaciriti vacyādeśaḥ | asyativaktikhyātibhya iti cerajādeśaḥ | vaca umityumāgamaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Who (को (*ko*)) truly knows (अद्धा वेद (*addhā veda*)) such a true matter? Who here (इह (*iha*)) will declare (प्र वोचत् (*pra vocat*)) what is known about it? What is said? With reference to the gods (देवानच्छ (*devānaccha*)), what path (पथ्या (*pathyā*)), good and proper on the road, goes (समेति (*sameti*)) rightly, arrives properly? No one knows this matter; no one tells it." Do those gods then exist? He answers: certainly. The lower (अवमा (*avamā*)), downward-facing abodes (सदांसि (*sadāṃsi*)) of these gods, who stand in the sky in the form of stars, are seen (ददृश्रे (*dadṛśre*)). Yet in the highest (परेषु (*pareṣu*)), hidden (गुह्येषु (*guhyeṣu*)), hard-to-know rites (व्रतेषु (*vrateṣu*)) that are performed, which ...

Sāyaṇa concludes his comment on the previous verse. The abodes of the gods are to be found in heaven, and no one but the Veda knows the road by which to reach them; this is the intended sense. The rest of the block is grammatical (the accent of अद्धा (*addhā*), the formation of वोचत् (*vocat*)) and is left to the grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- अद्धा (*addhā*)—the path that makes known the true meaning
- कः वेद (*kaḥ veda*)—who indeed knows
- इह (*iha*)—in this matter
- कः (*kaḥ*)—who indeed
- प्र वोचत् (*pra vocat*)—can declare the settled meaning
- का पथ्या (*kā pathyā*)—what path
- देवान् अच्छ (*devān accha*)—facing the gods
- समेति (*sameti*)—takes one along (that too no one can know)
- एषाः (*eṣāḥ*)—of these gods who are in the form of stars
- अवमा (*avamā*)—downward-facing
- सदांसि (*sadāṃsi*)—only the abodes
- ददृश्रे (*dadṛśre*)—are seen
- परेषु (*pareṣu*)—and the superior
- गुह्येषु (*guhyeṣu*)—and the hidden
- व्रतेषु (*vrateṣu*)—of the gods engaged in rites
- या (*yā*)—whichever abodes there are (no one can know them)

Gist

Who indeed knows the path that makes known the true meaning? Who in this matter can declare the settled meaning? No one can know the path that leads one towards the gods. Only the downward-facing abodes of the gods who are in the form of stars are seen. No one can know the hidden abodes of the gods who are engaged in rites that are both superior and mysterious.

English translation

Who knows what is the truth, or who may here declare it? what is the proper path that leads to the gods? their inferior abiding places are beheld, as are those which (are situated) in superior mysterious rites.

Special Topics

By the sentences को अद्धा वेद क इह प्रवोचत् का पथ्या अच्छा देवान् समिति (*ko addhā veda ka iha pravocat kā pathyā acchā devān samiti*) it is said that the nature of the gods, and the straight path by which to obtain their grace, can neither be known with certainty by anyone nor even be made known to others. It is also said that the greatness of Heaven and Earth, who contain such gods as if in subtle form, is beyond turning back. And it is said that this path, which is suited to reaching these gods seen in the form of stars, can be known through knowledge of the meaning of the Vedas and through performance of the rites the Vedas teach; thus the abundant greatness of the Vedas is declared. Sāyaṇa has expressed this idea in the sentence या परेषु गुह्येषु व्रतेषु ददृश्रे (*yā pareṣu guhyeṣu vrateṣu dadṛśre*) — उत्तमेषु दुर्ज्ञानेषु कर्मसु अनुष्ठितेषु यानि दिवि देवस्थानानि लभ्यंते तत्रा गंतुं को मार्ग इति वेदमंतरेण न कश्चित् जानाति (*uttameṣu durjñāneṣu karmasu anuṣṭhiteṣu yāni divi devasthānāni labhyaṃte tatrā gaṃtuṃ ko mārga iti vedamaṃtareṇa na kaścit jānāti*).

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒विर्नृ॒चक्षा॑ अ॒भि षी॑मचष्ट ऋ॒तस्य॒ योना॒ विघृ॑ते॒ म
द॑न्ती ।
नाना॑ चक्राते॒ सद॑नं॒ यथा॒ वेः स॑मा॒नेन॒ क्रतु॑ना सं
विदा॒ने ॥ ६ ॥

> *kavirnṛcakṣā abhi ṣīmacaṣṭa ṛtasya yonā vighṛte madantī |*
> *nānā cakrāte sadanaṃ yathā veḥ samānena kratunā saṃvidāne ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कविः । नृचक्षाः । अभि । सीं । अचष्ट । ऋतस्य । योना । विघृते इति विघृते ।
> मदंती इति ।
> नाना । चक्राते इति । सदनं । यथा । वेः । समानेन । क्रतुना । संविदाने इति
> संविदाने ॥ ६ ॥

> *kaviḥ | nṛcakṣāḥ | abhi | sīṃ | acaṣṭa | ṛtasya | yonā | vighṛte iti*
> *vighṛte |*
> *madaṃtī iti |*
> *nānā | cakrāte iti | sadanaṃ | yathā | veḥ | samānena | kratunā |*
> *saṃvidāne iti*
> *saṃvidāne ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> कविः क्रांतदर्शि नृचक्षा नृणां द्रष्टा सूर्यः सीमेते द्यावापृथिव्यावभ्यचष्ट । सर्वतः पश्यति ।
> ऋतस्य योना जलस्य स्थानेऽंतरिक्षे मदंती हृष्यंत्यौ
> विघृते । घृतमस्या ओषधयो जलममुष्या इति । एवंविधरसोपेते समानेन ।
> समानमेतदुदकमुच्चैत्यव चाहभिः । भूमिं पर्जन्या जिन्वंति दिवं जिन्वंत्यग्नय
> इति परस्परप्रीणनाख्येनैकेन क्रतुना कर्मणा संविदाने परस्परमैकमत्यं प्राप्ते
> ते द्यावापृथिव्यौ नाना पृथग्भूतं सदनं स्थानं चक्राते । तथा च श्रुतिः । इमौ वै
> लोकौ सहास्तां तौ व्यैतामिति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । यथा वेः कुलायं नाना भवति
> तद्वत् ॥ अचष्ट । चक्षिज् व्यक्तायां वाचीत्यस्य लजः स्कोः संयोगाद्योरिति
> ककारलोपः । निघातः । संविदाने । विद ज्ञान इत्यस्य समो गमीत्यादिनात्मनेपदे
> शानच् । चित्तावंतोदात्तः ॥

> *kaviḥ krāṃtadarśi nṛcakṣā nṛṇāṃ draṣṭā sūryaḥ sīmete*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyāvabhyacaṣṭa | sarvataḥ paśyati | ṛtasya yonā jalasya*
> *sthāne 'ṃtarikṣe madaṃtī hṛṣyaṃtyau*
> *vighṛte | ghṛtamasyā oṣadhayo jalamamuṣyā iti | evaṃvidharasopete*
> *samānena |*
> *samānametadudakamuccaityava cāhabhiḥ | bhūmiṃ parjanyā jinvaṃti*
> *divaṃ jinvaṃtyagnaya*
> *iti parasparaprīṇanākhyenaikena kratunā karmaṇā saṃvidāne*
> *parasparamaikamatyaṃ prāpte*

> *te dyāvāpṛthivyau nānā pṛthagbhūtaṃ sadanaṃ sthānaṃ cakrāte | tathā ca śrutiḥ | imau vai*
> *lokau sahāstāṃ tau vyaitāmiti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | yathā veḥ kulāyaṃ nānā bhavati*
> *tadvat ‖ acaṣṭa | cakṣij vyaktāyāṃ vācītyasya lajaḥ skoḥ saṃyogādyoriti kakāralopaḥ | nighātaḥ | saṃvidāne | vida jñāna ityasya samo gamītyādinātmanepade*
> *śānac | cittāvaṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

कविः (*kaviḥ*) is the far-seeing one; नृचक्षाः (*nṛcakṣāḥ*) is the beholder of men, the Sun. He looks all round at these two, Heaven and Earth (सीं (*sīṃ*)). ऋतस्य योना (*ṛtasya yonā*): in the place of water, the atmosphere, the two are rejoicing. विघृते (*vighṛte*): of one of them the ghee is the herbs, of the other the water, as the text says, "ghee of this one is the herbs, water of that one"; so they are endowed with such juices. समानेन (*samānena*): "common is this water, rising and falling with the days; the clouds gladden the earth, the fires gladden the sky." Thus, by one rite, called the mutual gratifying, the two have attained mutual agreement (संविदाने (*saṃvidāne*)); yet Heaven and Earth have made (चक्राते (*cakrāte*)) separate abodes (नाना सदनं (*nānā sadanaṃ*)). The śruti says likewise: "These two worlds were together; they parted." The illustration: as the nest of a bird is separate, so are theirs.

Word-to-word meaning

- कविः (*kaviḥ*)—the far-seeing one
- नृचक्षाः (*nṛcakṣāḥ*)—Āditya, who looks upon all creatures
- सीं (*sīṃ*)—these Heaven and Earth
- अभि अचष्ट (*abhi acaṣṭa*)—looks at all round
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of water
- योना (*yonā*)—in the atmosphere, the place of origin
- मदंती (*madaṃtī*)—rejoicing
- विघृते (*vighṛte*)—Heaven and Earth, of diverse juices
- वेः यथा (*veḥ yathā*)—as birds build separate nests
- नाना (*nānā*)—different

- सदनं (*sadanaṃ*)—dwelling-place
- चक्राते (*cakrāte*)—though they have made
- समानेन क्रतुना (*samānena kratunā*)—by rites that help one another
- संविधाने (*saṃvidhāne*)—they have attained agreement

Gist

Āditya, the far-seeing one, who looks upon all creatures, looks all round at these Heaven and Earth. Though Heaven and Earth, rejoicing in the atmosphere, the place where water originates, and of diverse juices, have made separate dwelling-places, as birds build separate nests, they have attained agreement through rites that help one another.

English translation

The far-seeing beholder of mankind (the sun), surveys this heaven and earth, rejoicing when deficient in moisture in the womb of the waters (the firmament), both concurrnig in community (of function), although they occupy various dwellings, like the diversified nests of a bird.

Special Topics

ऋतस्य योना मदंती विधृते समानेन क्रतुना संविदाने (*ṛtasya yonā madaṃtī vidhṛte samānena kratunā saṃvidāne*)—जलस्य स्थाने अंतरिक्षे हृष्यंत्यौ परस्परमैकमत्यं प्राप्ते ते द्यावापृथिव्यौ । (*jalasya sthāne aṃtarikṣe hṛṣyaṃtyau parasparamaikamatyaṃ prāpte te dyāvāpṛthivyau* |). The word ṛta is listed among the names of water (Ni. 3-24). Heaven and Earth dwell in joy in the atmosphere, where all the waters gather. They practise mutual helpfulness: the atmosphere supplies water to the earth, and the earth supplies the ghee fit for sacrifice. By this exchange of work the two bring about each other's growth. Sāyaṇa explains this idea with परस्परप्रीणनाख्येन कर्मणा परस्परमैकमत्यं प्राप्ते (*parasparaprīṇanākhyèna karmaṇā parasparamaikamatyaṃ prāpte*) and quotes the sentence समानमेतदुदकमुच्छैत्यवचाहभिः । भूमिं पर्जन्या जिन्वंति दिवं जिन्वंत्यग्नयः (*samānametadudakamucchaityavacāhabhiḥ | bhūmiṃ parjanyā jinvaṃti divaṃ jinvaṃtyagnayaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-51).

From these activities of Heaven and Earth, नाना सदनं चक्राते (*nānā sadanaṃ cakrāte*)—पृथग्भूतं स्थानं चक्राते (*pṛthagbhūtaṃ sthānaṃ cakrāte*): they have made separate places. Having explained the meaning thus, Sāyaṇa cites on this point the sentence इमौ वै लोकौ सहा स्तां तौ वैतां (*imau vai lokau sahā stāṃ tau vaitāṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 4-27).

यथा वेः—कुलायं नाना भवति तद्वत् (*yathā veḥ—kulāyaṃ nānā bhavati tadvat*): as a bird builds its nests in many ways to suit itself, so Heaven and Earth have made places of many kinds; this too is explained. Moreover, their living in agreement is for the benefit of the world. That the Āditya also helps in this matter is stated by the sentence नृचक्षाः सीं अभि अचष्ट (*nṛcakṣāḥ sīṃ abhi acaṣṭa*)—नृणां द्रष्टा सूर्यः एतौ द्यावापृथिवी सर्वतः पश्यति (*nṛṇāṃ draṣṭā sūryaḥ etau dyāvāpṛthivī sarvataḥ paśyati*).

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒मा॒न्या वियु॑ते दू॒रेअ॑न्ते ध्रु॒वे प॒दे त॑स्थतुर्जाग॒रूके॑
।
उ॒त स्वसा॑रा यु॒वती भव॑न्ती॒ आदु॑ ब्रुवाते मिथु॒ना
नि॒ नाम॑ ॥ ७ ॥

> *samānyā viyute dūreante dhruve pade tasthaturjāgarūke |*
> *uta svasārā yuvatī bhavantī ādu bruvāte mithunāni nāma ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> समान्या । वियुते इति वियुते । दूरेअंते इति दूरेअंते । ध्रुवे । पदे ।
> तस्थतुः । जागरूके इति ।
> उत । स्वसारा । युवती इति । भवंती इति । आत् । ऊं इति । ब्रुवाते इति । मिथुनानि ।
> नाम ॥ ७ ॥

> *samānyā | viyute iti viyute | dūreaṃte iti dūreaṃte | dhruve | pade | tasthatuḥ | jāgarūke iti |*
> *uta | svasārā | yuvatī iti | bhavaṃtī iti | āt | ūṃ iti | bruvāte iti | mithunāni | nāma ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> समान्या समाने परस्परप्रीणनाख्येन कर्मणैकमत्यं गते वियुते वियुज्य
> वर्तमाने दूरेअंते । दूरेंतोऽवसानं ययोस्ते दूरेअंते । अविनाशिन्यौ
> ते द्यावापृथिव्यौ जागरूके जागरणशीले सत्यौ ध्रुवेऽविनाशिनि पदेऽंतरिक्षे तस्थतुः ।
> तिष्ठतः । उतापि च युवती नित्यतरुणे स्वसारा भगिन्यावेकस्मादात्मनो जाते इति
> भवंती तस्थतुरित्यन्वयः । आदनंतरं मिथुनानि द्वंद्वानि नाम उर्वि पृथ्वी बहुले
> दूरेअंते रोदसी पुरोहिते इत्यादीनि नामानि ब्रुवाते । ते परस्परं ब्रूतः ।
> उर्वादिभिर्द्वंद्वनामभिर्दावापृथिव्यावुच्येते इत्यर्थः ॥ समान्या । सुपां सुलुगिति
> विभक्तेर्डादेशः । दूरेअंते । इण् गतौ । दुरीणो लोपश्च । उ. २–२० । इति
> रक्षृत्ययो धातोर्लोपश्च । रो रीति रेफलोपः । ढ्रलोप इति दीर्घः ।
> अंतशब्दोऽमेरसिहसीत्यादिना तन्नत्ययांतः । सप्तम्युपमानेति बहुव्रीहिः । हलदंता–

> *samānyā samāne parasparaprīṇanākhyena karmaṇaikamatyaṃ gate viyute viyujya*
> *vartamāne dūreaṃte | dūreṃto 'vasānaṃ yayoste dūreaṃte | avināśinyau*
> *te dyāvāpṛthivyau jāgarūke jāgaraṇaśīle satyau dhruve 'vināśini pade 'ṃtarikṣe tasthatuḥ |*
> *tiṣṭhataḥ | utāpi ca yuvatī nityataruṇe svasārā bhaginyāvekasmādātmano jāte iti*
> *bhavaṃtī tasthaturityanvayaḥ | ādanaṃtaraṃ mithunāni dvaṃdvāni nāma urvi pṛthvī bahule*
> *dūreaṃte rodasī purohite ityādīni nāmāni bruvāte | te parasparaṃ brūtaḥ |*
> *urvādibhirdvaṃdvanāmabhirdāvāpṛthivyāvucyete ityarthaḥ ‖ samānyā | supāṃ sulugiti*
> *vibhakterḍādeśaḥ | dūreaṃte | iṇ gatau | durīṇo lopaśca | u. 2-20 | iti*
> *rakṣṛtyayo dhātorlopaśca | ro rīti rephalopaḥ | ḍhralopa iti dīrghaḥ |*
> *aṃtaśabdo 'merasihasītyādinā tannatyayāṃtaḥ | saptamyupamāneti bahuvrīhiḥ | haladaṃtā-*

> दिति सप्तम्या अलुक् । पूर्वपदस्वरः । जागरूके । जागृ निद्राक्षय इत्यस्मात्ताच्छेल्यार्थे जागरूकः । पा. ३–२–१६५ । इत्येकप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । स्वसारा । न षट्स्वस्रादिभ्य इति जीपः प्रतिषेधः ॥

> *diti saptamyā aluk | pūrvapadasvaraḥ | jāgarūke | jāgṛ nidrākṣaya ityasmāttācchelyārthe jāgarūkaḥ | pā. 3-2-165 | ityekapratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | svasārā | na ṣaṭsvasrādibhya iti jīpaḥ pratiṣedhaḥ ||*

Summary

समान्या (*samānyā*): the two being common, having reached agreement through the rite called the mutual gratifying; वियुते (*viyute*): remaining apart; दूरेअंते (*dūreaṃte*): those whose end is far away. These two, Heaven and Earth, being imperishable and जागरूके (*jāgarūke*), vigilant, stand in the firm, imperishable station, the atmosphere. Also, being युवती (*yuvatī*), ever young, and स्वसारा (*svasārā*), two sisters born of one self, they stand; this is the construction. After that, मिथुनानि (*mithunāni*), pairs, नाम (*nāma*), names such as उर्वि पृथ्वी बहुले दूरेअंते रोदसी पुरोहिते (*urvi pṛthvī bahule dūreaṃte rodasī purohite*) and others, ब्रुवाते (*bruvāte*), they say to each other; that is, Heaven and Earth are called by pair-names beginning with Urvī. The remainder of the block is grammatical derivation.

This block contains only the remaining grammatical derivations (of जागरूके(*jāgarūke*) and स्वसारा (*svasārā*)), which are left to the grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- समान्या (*samānyā*)—those who have attained agreement through mutually helpful acts
- वियुते (*viyute*)—those who are separate
- दूरेअंते (*dūreaṃte*)—those who are far away; Heaven and Earth
- जागरूके(*jāgarūke*)—intent on their tasks
- ध्रुवे (*dhruve*)—eternal
- पदे (*pade*)—in the station of the atmosphere
- तस्थतुः (*tasthatuḥ*)—have been established
- उत (*uta*)—and
- युवती (*yuvatī*)—ever young

- स्वसारा (*svasārā*)—being sisters
- भवंती (*bhavaṃtī*)—are
- अदु (*adu*)—afterwards
- मिथुनानि नाम (*mithunāni nāma*)—names in pairs
- ब्रुवाते (*bruvāte*)—they designate and call

Gist

Heaven and Earth, who have attained agreement through mutually helpful acts and are far away, intent on their tasks, have been established in the eternal station of the atmosphere; and, ever young and sisterly, they are designated and called by names in pairs.

English translation

Common (in function), disjoined, of distant termination, they remain vigilant in a permanent station : being, as it were, sisters, and ever young : they therefore address each other by twin appellations.

Special Topics

Because Heaven and Earth are mutually helpful (that is, for water to gather on the earth the atmosphere, and for water to gather in the atmosphere the earth, carry out their tasks in agreement), though separate in nature they live in agreement. It is described that, being ever young, abiding in an eternal place, being always devoted and intent on their respective tasks, and being born of the Self, they are designated and dealt with by pair-names only.

आदु मिथुनानि नाम ब्रुवाते (*ādu mithunāni nāma bruvāte*)—आनंतरं उर्व्यादिभिः द्वंद्वनामभिर्द्यावापृथिव्यावुच्येते (*ānaṃtaraṃ urvyādibhiḥ dvaṃdvanāmabhirdyāvāpṛthivyāvucyete*). The Nirukta authors, when reciting the names of Heaven and Earth, have designated them in pair form only. It is explained that their origin, their activity and their state are the chief reason for reciting them thus.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

विश्वेदे॒ते जनि॑मा॒ सं वि॑विक्तो म॒हो दे॒वान्बिभ्र॑ती॒ न व्य॑थेते ।
एज॑द्ध्रु॒वं प॑त्यते॒ विश्व॒मेकं॒ चर॑त्पत॒त्रि विषु॑णं॒ वि जा॒तम् ॥ ८ ॥

> *viśvedete janimā saṃ vivikto maho devānbibhratī na vyathete |*
> *ejaddhruvaṃ patyate viśvamekaṃ caratpatatri viṣuṇaṃ vi jātam ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विश्वा । इत् । एते इति । जनिमा । सं । विविक्तः । महः । देवान् । बिभ्रती इति । न ।
> व्यथेते इति ।
> एजत् । ध्रुवं । पत्यते । विश्वं । एकं । चरत् । पतत्रि । विषुणं । वि । जातं ॥ ८ ॥

> *viśvā | it | ete iti | janimā | saṃ | viviktaḥ | mahaḥ | devān | bibhratī iti | na |*
> *vyathete iti |*
> *ejat | dhruvaṃ | patyate | viśvaṃ | ekaṃ | carat | patatri | viṣuṇaṃ | vi | jātaṃ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> एते द्यावापृथिव्यौ विश्वेज्जनिम सर्वाण्यपि भूतजातानि सं विविक्तः । अवकाशप्रदानेन संविभज्य कुरुतः । किंच महो महतो देवानिंद्रसूर्यादीन् सरित्समुद्रपर्वतादींश्च बिभ्रती बिभ्राणे आपि न व्यथेते । न खिद्येते । किंच विजज्जंगमात्मकं ध्रुवं स्थावरात्मकं च विश्वं जगदेकं स्थानं पृथिवीमेव सत्यते । अभिगच्छति ।
> तथा चरच्चंचलं पशुजातं पतत्रि पक्षिजातं च विषुणं विश्वक् नानारूपमनयोर्मध्ये वितिष्ठते । योग्यक्रियाध्याहारः ॥ विविक्तः । विचिर् पृथग्भावे । जुहोत्यादिः ।
> निघातः । बिभ्रती । डुब्बञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्य शतरि नाभ्यस्ताच्छतुरिति नुमभावः । अभ्यस्तस्वरः । विजत् । एजृ कंपने । शतरि रूपं । सत्यते । पद गतौ । दिवादिरात्मनेपदी । दकारस्य तकारो व्यत्ययेन । निघातः ॥

> *ete dyāvāpṛthivyau viśvejjanima sarvāṇyapi bhūtajātāni saṃ viviktaḥ | avakāśapradānena saṃvibhajya kurutaḥ | kiṃca maho mahato devāniṃdrasūryādīn saritsamudraparvatādīṃśca bibhratī bibhrāṇe āpi na vyathete | na khidyete | kiṃca vijajjaṃgamātmakaṃ dhruvaṃ sthāvarātmakaṃ ca viśvaṃ jagadekaṃ sthānaṃ pṛthivīmeva satyate | abhigacchati |*
>
> *tathā caraccaṃcalaṃ paśujātaṃ patatri pakṣijātaṃ ca viṣuṇaṃ viśvak nānārūpamanayormadhyè vitiṣṭhate | yogyakriyādhyāhāraḥ ‖ viviktaḥ | vicir pṛthagbhāve | juhotyādiḥ |*
>
> *nighātaḥ | bibhratī | ḍubbañ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasya śatari nābhyastācchaturiti numabhāvaḥ | abhyastasvaraḥ | vijat | ejṛ kaṃpane | śatari rūpaṃ | satyate | pada gatau | divādirātmanepadī | dakārasya takāro vyatyayena | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

These two, Heaven and Earth, विश्वेज्जनिम (*viśvejjanima*), all beings, सं विविक्तः (*saṃ viviktaḥ*), separate and set apart by giving them room. Further, महः (*mahaḥ*), the great gods, Indra, Sūrya and others, and rivers, seas, mountains and the like, they bear, and yet न व्यथेते (*na vyathete*), they are not wearied. Further, the moving एजत् (*ejat*) and the standing ध्रुवं (*dhruvaṃ*) world, the whole विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*), goes to one place, the earth alone. So too the moving herds of animals चरत् (*carat*) and the flocks of birds पतत्रि (*patatri*), of manifold forms, stand between these two; a suitable verb is to be supplied. The rest of the block is grammatical derivation.

Word-to-word meaning

- एते (*ete*)—these Heaven and Earth
- विश्वेत् (*viśvet*)—all
- जनिम (*janima*)—beings
- सं विविक्तः (*saṃ viviktaḥ*)—have separated and placed in their places
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—of great nature
- देवान् (*devān*)—the gods, Indra and others
- बिभ्रती (*bibhratī*)—though bearing
- न व्यथेते (*na vyathete*)—they do not suffer weariness

- विजत् (*vijat*)—what is moving
- ध्रुवं (*dhruvaṃ*)—and what is standing
- विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)—the whole world too
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—one place (in the form of the earth)
- पत्यते (*patyate*)—resorts to
- चरत् (*carat*)—animals and others that move about
- पतत्रि (*patatri*)—birds
- विषुणं (*viṣuṇaṃ*)—being of manifold forms
- वि (*vi*)—are placed (between Heaven and Earth)

Gist

Heaven and earth have separated all the beings that have come into being and placed them in their own places. Though they bear the gods, Indra and the others, who are of great nature, they suffer no distress. The whole world, moving and stationary alike, rests on one single place, which is of the form of the earth. The animals and others that move about, and the birds, being of many forms, are established between heaven and earth and move about.

English translation

These two keep all born things discrete, and, although comprehending the great divinities, are not distressed : all moving and stationary beings rest upon one (basis), whether animals, or birds, or creatures of various kinds.

Special Topics

By the sentences एते विश्वेत् संविविक्तः महः देर्वा बिभ्रती न व्यथेते (*ete viśvet saṃviviktaḥ mahaḥ dervā bibhratī na vyathete*) it is made clear that heaven and earth provide room for all living beings to exist separately; and that, although they bear gods such as Indra, who are of abundant power, and also rivers, oceans and mountains, no distress arises in them from this. The greatness of heaven and earth is described both because the earth bears the beings that exist in stationary and moving forms, and because the atmosphere provides room for the birds, which are of the nature of moving creatures.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सना॑ पुरा॒णमध्ये॑म्या॒रान्म॒हः पि॒तुर्ज॑नि॒तुर्जा॒मि तन्न॑ः ।
दे॒वासो॒ यत्र॑ पनि॒ता॒र एवै॑रु॒रौ प॒थि व्यु॑ते त॒स्थुर॒न्तः ॥ ९ ॥

> *sanā purāṇamadhyemyārānmahaḥ piturjaniturjāmi tannaḥ |*
> *devāso yatra panitāra evairurau pathi vyute tasthurantaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सना । पुराणं । अधि । एमि । आरात् । महः । पितुः । जनितुः । जामि । तत् । नः ।
> देवासः । यत्र । पनितारः । एवैः । उरौ । पथि । विउते ! तस्थुः । अंतरिति ॥ ९ ॥

> *sanā | purāṇaṃ | adhi | emi | ārāt | mahaḥ | pituḥ | janituḥ | jāmi | tat | naḥ |*
> *devāsaḥ | yatra | panitāraḥ | evaiḥ | urau | pathi | viute ! tasthuḥ | aṃtariti ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे द्यौर्महो महत्याः पितुः सर्वस्य पालयित्रा जनितुर्जनयित्रास्तव पना सनातनं पुराणं पूर्वक्रमागतं नोऽस्माकं तज्ञामि जामित्वं । सर्वमेकस्माज्ञातमिति द्यौर्भगिनी भवति । तादृशं भगिनीत्वं तदारादधुनाध्येमि । स्मरामि । दिवः पितृत्वे जनयितृत्वे च मंत्रवर्णः । द्यौर्मे पिता जनिता नाभिरत्र! ऋग्वे १–१६४–३३। इति । यत्र यस्यां दिव्यंतर्मध्य उरौ विस्तीर्णे व्युते विविक्ते पथि नभसि पनितारस्त्वां स्तुवंते देवासो देवा एवैर्गमनसाधनैः स्वैः स्वैर्वाहनैः सहिताः संतस्तस्थुः । तत्र स्थिता देवा मदीयं स्तोत्रं शृण्वंतिति भावः ॥ पुराणं । पुराशब्दात् शैषिकार्थे सायंचिरमिति ट्युप्रत्ययः । पुराणप्रोक्तेषु ब्राह्मणकल्पेष्विति निपातनात्तुडभावः । निपातनादेवांतोदात्तत्वं । एमि । इक् स्मरणे । अदादिः । लटि रूपं । निघातः । व्युते । वेञ् त्यतुसंताने । कर्मणि क्तः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरः । तस्तुः । तिष्ठतेर्लिट रूपं । यत्रयोगादनिघातः ॥

> *he dyaurmaho mahatyāḥ pituḥ sarvasya pālayitrā janiturjanayitrāstava panā sanātanaṃ purāṇaṃ pūrvakramāgataṃ no 'smākaṃ tajñāmi jāmitvaṃ | sarvamekasmājñātamiti dyaurbhaginī bhavati | tādṛśaṃ*

> *bhaginītvaṃ tadārādadhunādhyemi | smarāmi | divaḥ*
> *pitṛtve janayittṛtve ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | dyaurme pitā janitā nābhiratra! ṛgve 1-164-33|*
> *iti | yatra yasyāṃ divyaṃtarmadhya urau vistīrṇe vyute vivikte pathi nabhasi panitārastvāṃ*
> *stuvaṃte devāso devā evairgamanasādhanaiḥ svaiḥ svairvāhanaiḥ sahitā: saṃtastasthuḥ |*
> *tatra sthitā devā madīyaṃ stotraṃ śṛṇvaṃtiti bhāvaḥ ‖ purāṇaṃ |*
> *purāśabdāt śaiṣikārthe sāyaṃciramiti ṭyupratyayaḥ | purāṇaprokteṣu*
> *brāhmaṇakalpeṣṭiti nipātanāttuḍabhāvaḥ | nipātanādevāṃtodāttatvaṃ | emi | ik smaraṇe | adādiḥ | laṭi rūpaṃ |*
> *nighātaḥ | vyute | veñ tyatusaṃtāne | karmaṇi ktaḥ | yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ |*
> *gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ prakṛtisvaraḥ | tastuḥ | tiṣṭhaterliṭa rūpaṃ | yatrayogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Heaven (Dyaus), you are great, the protectress of all and the begetter. That ancient kinship with us, descended in due order from earlier times, is the relation of a sister: it is said that "Dyaus is a sister", since everything is born from one. I now call to mind that sisterhood. For Heaven's being father and begetter there is a mantra text: द्यौर्मे पिता जनिता नाभिरत्र (*dyaurme pitā janitā nābhiratra*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-33). In the middle of heaven, in the wide, separated path, the gods, your praisers, stand together with their own vehicles, the means of travel; the meaning is that the gods standing there hear my praise.

Word-to-word meaning

- महः (*mahaḥ*)—she who is of great nature
- पितुः (*pituḥ*)—the protectress
- जनितुः (*janituḥ*)—the cause of origin, the deity presiding over the heaven-world
- सना (*sanā*)—eternal
- पुराणं (*purāṇaṃ*)—come down continuously from of old
- नः (*naḥ*)—that is with us

- तत् जामि (*tat jāmi*)—that kinship
- आरात् (*ārāt*)—now
- अध्येमि (*adhyemi*)—I call to mind
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this same heaven
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the middle
- उता (*utā*)—that is wide
- व्युते (*vyute*)—that is separate
- पथि (*pathi*)—on the path
- पनितारः (*panitāraḥ*)—those who praise you
- देवासः (*devāsaḥ*)—Indra and others, of divine nature
- ऐवैः (*èvaiḥ*)—with their own horses
- तस्थुः (*tasthuḥ*)—are stationed

Gist

The deity of the heaven-world, who is of great nature, protectress and cause of origin, I now call to mind that eternal kinship with us, come down continuously from of old. In the middle of this same heaven, on the wide and separate path, Indra and the other gods, who praise you and are of divine nature, are stationed with their own horses.

English translation

I consider at present the eternal and ancient sisterhood to us of you, our great protectress and progenitrix, within whose vast and separated path your eulogists, the gods, travel in their chariots.

Special Topics

It is described that the deity Heaven is a kinsman to all who have been born, because she is the cause of their origin and their protectress, and that this kinship has existed from very ancient times. In this matter the mantra दौर्मे पिता जनिता नाभिरत्र (*daurme pitā janitā nābhiratra*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-174-33) is cited.[?102]

It is described that in the heaven-world made by this deity for the gods' travelling, the gods, moving about with their own vehicles, praise this deity Heaven in the separate and wide atmosphere; and that these gods may hear the hymns recited by the Ṛtvijs in the sacrifices performed by the sacrificer.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मं स्तोमं॑ रोदसी॒ प्र ब्र॑वीम्यृदू॒दरा॑ः शृणवन्नग्निजि॒ह्वाः ।
मि॒त्रः स॒म्राजो॒ वरु॑णो॒ युवा॑न आदि॒त्यास॑ः क॒वय॑ः पप्रथा॒नाः ॥ १० ॥

> *imaṃ stomaṃ rodasī pra bravīmyṛdūdarāḥ śṛṇavannagnijihvāḥ |*
> *mitraḥ samrājo varuṇo yuvāna ādityāsaḥ kavayaḥ paprathānāḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमं। स्तोमं । रोदसी इति । प्र । ब्रवीमि । यदूदराः। शृणवन् । अग्निजिह्वाः ।
> मित्रः । सम्रराजः । वरुणः । युवानः । आदित्यासः । कवयः । पप्रथानाः ॥ १० ॥

> *imaṃ| stomaṃ | rodasī iti | pra | bravīmi | yadūdarāḥ| śṛṇavan | agnijihvāḥ |*
> *mitraḥ | samrarājaḥ | varuṇaḥ | yuvānaḥ | ādityāsaḥ | kavayaḥ | paprathānāḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्याविमं युष्मदीयं स्तोमं प्र ब्रवीमि । प्रकर्षण वदामि । ऋदूदराः । ऋदु मृदु उदरं येषां ते ऋदूदराः । यद्वा ।
> मृदुरुदरे सोमो–येषां ते ऋदूदराः । अग्निजिह्वाः । अग्निर्जिह्वास्थानीयो
> येषां ते तथोक्ताः । सम्राजः सम्यग्दीप्यमाना युवानो नित्यतरुणाः । यद्वा ।
> यजमानानभिमतफलैर्मिश्रीकुर्वंतः । कवयः क्रांतदर्शिनः पप्रथानाः स्वानि स्वानि
> कर्माणः प्रथयंतो मित्रादयो देवाः शृणवन् । तदिदं स्तोत्रं शृण्वंतु ॥

> *he rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyāvimaṃ yuṣmadīyaṃ stomaṃ pra bravīmi |*
> *prakarṣaṇa vadāmi | ṛdūdarāḥ | ṛdu mṛdu udaraṃ yeṣāṃ te ṛdūdarāḥ |*
> *yadvā |*
> *mṛdurudare somo-yeṣāṃ te ṛdūdarāḥ | agnijihvāḥ | agnirjihvāsthānīyo*
> *yeṣāṃ te tathoktāḥ | samrājaḥ samyagdīpyamānā yuvāno nityataruṇāḥ*
> *| yadvā |*
> *yajamānānabhimataphalairmiśrīkurvaṃtaḥ | kavayaḥ krāṃtadarśinaḥ*
> *paprathānāḥ svāni svāni*
> *karmāṇaḥ prathayaṃto mitrādayo devāḥ śṛṇavan | tadidaṃ stotraṃ*
> *śṛṇvaṃtu ‖*

> शृणवन् । श्रु श्रवण इत्यस्य लेट्यडागमः । अग्निजिह्वाः । त्रिचक्रादित्वादंतोदात्तत्वं।
> पप्रथानाः । प्रथ प्रख्यान इत्यस्य कानचि रूपं । चित्तादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *śṛṇavan | śru śravaṇa ityasya leṭyaḍāgamaḥ | agnijihvāḥ |*
> *tricakrāditvādaṃtodāttatvaṃ|*
> *paprathānāḥ | pratha prakhyāna ityasya kānaci rūpaṃ |*
> *cittādaṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Heaven and Earth, I recite this your praise forcefully. ऋदूदराः (*ṛdūdarāḥ*): those whose belly is soft; or else, those in whose belly the Soma is soft. अग्निजिह्वाः (*agnijihvāḥ*): those whose tongue-substitute is Agni. सम्राजः (*samrājaḥ*): shining well; युवानः (*yuvānaḥ*): ever young; or else, those who mingle the sacrificers with the fruits they desire. कवयः (*kavayaḥ*): far-seeing; पप्रथानाः (*paprathānāḥ*): spreading abroad their own acts. May the gods, Mitra and the rest, hear; let them hear this praise.

Only grammar is given in this block.

Word-to-word meaning

- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—O heaven and earth
- इमं (*imaṃ*)—this, addressed to you
- स्तोमं (*stomaṃ*)—the praise
- प्र ब्रवीमि (*pra bravīmi*)—I recite
- युदूदराः (*yudūdarāḥ*)—those of soft belly
- अग्निजिह्वाः (*agnijihvāḥ*)—those who have Agni itself as tongue

- सम्राजः (*samrājaḥ*)—the shining ones
- युवानः (*yuvānaḥ*)—the ever young
- कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)—the far-seeing
- पप्रधानाः (*papradhānāḥ*)—those who carry out their own duties
- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—Mitra
- वरुणः (*varuṇaḥ*)—Varuṇa
- आदित्यासः (*ādityāsaḥ*)—the Ādityas also
- शृणवन् (*śṛṇavan*)—may they listen and hear

Gist

O heaven and earth, I recite this praise addressed to you. May Mitra, Varuṇa and the Ādityas, who have soft bellies, have Agni as their tongue, are shining, ever young, far-seeing, and fulfil their own duties, listen and hear it.

English translation

I repeat this hymn, heaven and earth, to you ; and may the soft-bellied, fire-tongued Mitra, royal Varuna, the youtful Adityas, all cognizant of the past, and proclaiming (their own acts), hear it.

Special Topics

ऋदूदरः- ऋदु मृदु उदरं येषां ते । यद्वा मृदुरुदरे सोमो येषां ते (*ṛdūdaraḥ- ṛdu mṛdu udaraṃ yeṣāṃ te | yadvā mṛdurudare somo yeṣāṃ te*). The word ऋदूदर (*ṛdūdara*) is explained by Yāska (Ni. 6-4) as ऋदूदरसोमो मृदुरुदुरेष्टिति वा (*ṛdūdarasomo mṛduruduresṭiti vā*). The nature of the gods is described: their belly is soft, or they bear soft Soma in the belly.

युवानः—नित्यतरुणाः । यद्वा यजमानान् अभिमतफलैः मिश्रीकुर्वंतः (*yuvānaḥ—nityataruṇāḥ | yadvā yajamānān abhimataphalaiḥ miśrīkurvaṃtaḥ*). The nature of the gods is explained: they are always in youth; or they favour the sacrificers who satisfy them with offerings of oblations, so that their wishes are fulfilled. It is explained that the gods, having such greatness, spreading abroad their duties, receiving oblations only through Agni, and ever shining, may hear the praises of heaven and earth recited by us the sacrificers.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

हिर॑ण्यपाणिः सवि॒ता सु॑जि॒ह्वस्त्रिरा दि॒वो वि॒दथे॒ पत्य॑मानः ।
दे॒वेषु॑ च सवित॒ः श्लोक॒मश्रे॒राद॒स्मभ्य॒मा सु॑व स॒र्वता॑तिम् ॥ ११ ॥

> *hiraṇyapāṇiḥ savitā sujihvastrirā divo vidathe patyamānaḥ |*
> *deveṣu ca savitaḥ ślokamaśrerādasmabhyamā suva sarvatātim ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> हिरण्यपाणिः । सविता । सुजिह्वः । त्रिः । आ । दिवः । विदथे । पत्यमानः ।
> देवेषु । च । सवितरिति । श्लोकं । अश्रेः । आत् । अस्मभ्यं । आ । सुव । सर्वतातिं ॥११॥

> *hiraṇyapāṇiḥ | savitā | sujihvaḥ | triḥ | ā | divaḥ | vidathe | patyamānaḥ |*
> *deveṣu | ca | savitariti | ślokaṃ | aśreḥ | āt | asmabhyaṃ | ā | suva | sarvatātiṃ ‖11‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हिरण्यपाणिः । दानार्थं हिरण्यं पाणौ हस्ते यस्य स तथोक्तः । यद्वा । देवकर्तृकयागे सवितुर्ऋत्विग्भूतस्य हस्ते प्राशित्रं भक्षणार्थमद्वर्यवो ददुः । तत्पाशित्रं तस्य हस्तौ चिच्छेद । ततोऽध्वयवो हिरण्ययौ हस्तौ कृत्वा संदधुः । ततोऽयं हिरण्यपाणिः । तथा च कौषीतकं । सवित्रे प्राशित्रं प्रतिजह्रुस्तत्तस्य पाणी प्रचिच्छेद तस्मै हिरण्ययौ प्रतिदधुस्तस्माद्धिरण्यपाणिरिति । सुजिह्वः । शोभनवाक् सविता विदथे यज्ञे त्रिस्तिषु सवनेषु दिवो नभसः सकाशादा पत्यमान आगच्छन् भवतीति शेषः । परोऽर्धर्चः प्रत्यक्षः । हे सवितस्त्वं देवेषु स्तोतृषु विद्यमानं च श्लोकं । श्लोक्यतेऽनेनेति श्लोकः स्तोत्रं । तदश्रेः । प्राप्नुहि च । आदनंतरं सर्वतातिं सर्वमपेक्षितं फलमस्मभ्यमा सुव । प्रेरय ॥ हिरण्यपाणिः । हिरण्यशब्दं यास्को बहुधा निर्वक्ति । हिरण्यं कस्माद्ध्रियत आयम्यमानमिति वा ह्रियते जनाज्ज्ञनमित्यादिना । नि. २–१० । पाणिशब्दं च निर्विवेच । पाणिः पणायतेः पूजाकर्मणः । नि. २–२६ । इति ॥ हर्य कांतिगत्योः । हर्यतेः कन्यन् हिर चेति कन्यन् हिर इत्ययमादेशो धातोः । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः ।

> पत्यमानः। पद गत्। दिवादिरात्मनेपदी । दकारस्य तकारश्चांदसः । अश्रेः। श्रिञ् सेवायामित्यस्य लजि बहुलं छंदसीति शपो लुक् । चवायोगे प्रथमेति न निघातः . सुव । षू प्रेरणे । तुदादिः । सर्वतातिं । सर्वदेवात्तातिल् स्वार्थिकः । लित्सर्वः ॥

> *hiraṇyapāṇiḥ | dānārthaṃ hiraṇyaṃ pāṇau haste yasya sa tathoktaḥ |*
> *yadvā |*
> *devakartṛkayāge saviturṛtvigbhūtasya haste prāśitraṃ*
> *bhakṣaṇārthamadvaryavo daduḥ |*
> *tatpāśitraṃ tasya hastau ciccheda | tato 'dhvayavo hiraṇyayau hastau*
> *kṛtvā saṃdadhuḥ |*
> *tato 'yaṃ hiraṇyapāṇiḥ | tathā ca kauṣītakaṃ | savitrè prāśitraṃ*
> *pratijahrustattasya pāṇī*
> *praciccheda tasmai hiraṇyayau pratidadhustasmāddhiraṇyapāṇiriti |*
> *sujihvaḥ | śobhanavāk savitā*
> *vidathe yajñe tristiṣu savaneṣu divo nabhasaḥ sakāśādā patyamāna*
> *āgacchan bhavatīti*
> *śeṣaḥ | paro 'rdharcaḥ pratyakṣaḥ | he savitastvaṃ deveṣu stotṛṣu*
> *vidyamānaṃ ca*
> *ślokaṃ | ślokyate 'neneti ślokaḥ stotraṃ | tadaśreḥ | prāppuhi ca |*
> *ādanaṃtaraṃ sarvatātiṃ sarvamapekṣitaṃ phalamasmabhyamā suva |*
> *preraya ‖ hiraṇyapāṇiḥ | hiraṇyaśabdaṃ*
> *yāsko bahudhā nirvakti | hiraṇyaṃ kasmāddhriyata āyamyamānamiti vā*
> *hriyate*
> *janājjanamityādinā | ni. 2-10 | pāṇiśabdaṃ ca nirviveca | pāṇiḥ*
> *paṇāyateḥ pūjākarmaṇaḥ | ni. 2-26 | iti ‖ harya kāṃtigatyoḥ | haryateḥ*
> *kanyan hira ceti kanyan*
> *hira ityayamādeśo dhātoḥ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ | bahuvrīhau*
> *pūrvapadasvaraḥ |*
> *patyamānaḥ| pada gat| divādirātmanepadī | dakārasya*
> *takāraścāṃdasaḥ | aśreḥ| śriñ sevāyāmityasya laji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti*
> *śapo luk | cavāyoge prathameti na nighātaḥ .*
> *suva | ṣū preraṇe | tudādiḥ | sarvatātiṃ | sarvadevāttātil svārthikaḥ |*
> *litsarvaḥ ‖*

Summary

हिरण्यपाणिः (*hiraṇyapāṇiḥ*): he in whose hand there is gold for giving. Or else: at a sacrifice performed by the gods, the Adhvaryus gave the Prāśitra to Savitṛ, who was an Ṛtvij, for eating; it cut off his hands, and the Adhvaryus made golden hands and attached them; hence he is golden-handed. So says the Kauṣītaka: सवित्रे प्राशित्रं प्रतिजह्रुस्तत्तस्य पाणी प्रचिच्छेद तस्मै हिरण्ययौ प्रतिदधुस्तस्माद्धिरण्यपाणिरिति (*savitrè prāśitraṃ pratijahrustattasya pāṇī praciccheda tasmai hiraṇyayau pratidadhustasmāddhiraṇyapāṇiriti*). सुजिह्वः (*sujihvaḥ*): of good speech. Savitṛ, at the sacrifice, at the three pressings, comes down from the sky. The second half-verse is direct address: O Savitṛ, accept the praise, श्लोक (*śloka*) (that by which one is praised, a hymn), existing among the gods, the praisers; and then grant us सर्वतातिं (*sarvatātiṃ*), every desired fruit. Yāska explains हिरण्य (*hiraṇya*) in many ways, beginning हिरण्यं कस्माद्ध्रियत (*hiraṇyaṃ kasmāddhriyata*) (Ni. 2-10), and पाणि (*pāṇi*): पाणिः पणायतेः पूजाकर्मणः (*pāṇiḥ paṇāyateḥ pūjākarmaṇaḥ*) (Ni. 2-26).

Word-to-word meaning

- हिरण्यपाणिः (*hiraṇyapāṇiḥ*)—he who has a hand of gold
- सुजिह्वः (*sujihvaḥ*)—he who has excellent speech
- सविता (*savitā*)—Savitṛ
- विदथे (*vidathe*)—at the sacrifice
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—at the three pressing times
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from the atmosphere
- आ पत्यमानः (*ā patyamānaḥ*)—comes down
- सवितः (*savitaḥ*)—O Savitṛ
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—made for the gods
- श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*)—the praise
- अश्रेः (*aśreḥ*)—accept
- आत् (*āt*)—thereafter
- सर्वतातिं (*sarvatātiṃ*)—the fruit desired by all
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—to us
- आ सुव (*ā suva*)—provide

Gist

Savitṛ, who has a hand of gold and excellent speech, comes down to the sacrifice at the three pressing times. O Savitṛ, accept the praise made for the gods. Thereafter provide us with the fruit desired by all.

English translation

The golden-handed, soft-tongued Savitri is descending from heaven (to be present) thrice (daily) at the sacrifice : accept, Savitri, the praise (recited by) the worshippers, and thereupon grant to us all our desires.

Special Topics

हिरण्यपाणिः सविता— दानार्थं हिरण्यं पाणौ यस्य (*hiraṇyapāṇiḥ savitā—dānārthaṃ hiraṇyaṃ pāṇau yasya*). Sāyaṇa explains the meaning as: the god Savitṛ holds gold in his hand for giving; and he gives another meaning for this phrase: यद्वा देवकर्तृकयागे सवितुः ऋत्विगूतस्य हस्ते प्राशित्रं भक्षणार्थमध्वर्यवो ददुः । तत्पाशित्रं तस्य हस्तौ चिच्छेद । ततो अध्वर्यवो हिरण्ययौ हस्तौ कृत्वा संदधुः । ततोऽयं हिरण्यपाणिः (*yadvā devakartṛkayāge savituḥ ṛtvigūtasya haste prāśitraṃ bhakṣaṇārthamadhvaryavo daduḥ | tatpāśitraṃ tasya hastau ciccheda | tato adhvaryavo hiraṇyayau hastau kṛtvā saṃdadhuḥ | tato 'yaṃ hiraṇyapāṇiḥ*). And so the Kauṣītaka: “सवित्रे प्राशित्रं प्रतिजह्रुः तत्तस्य पाणी प्रचिच्छेद तस्मै हिरण्ययौ प्रतिदधुः तस्मात् हिरण्यपाणिः (*savitre prāśitraṃ pratijahruḥ tattasya pāṇī praciccheda tasmai hiraṇyayau pratidadhuḥ tasmāt hiraṇyapāṇiḥ*)”. When the gods performed a sacrifice, they offered the oblation into the hand of the god Savitṛ. It cut off his hand. Then the Adhvaryus made a hand of gold and joined it; from this the name Hiraṇyapāṇi became famous: thus the second meaning is explained. It is expressed as a wish that this god come to the sacrificial hall of the sacrificer performing the sacrifice. Yāska has explained the meaning of the word हिरण्य (*hiraṇya*) and of the word पाणि (*pāṇi*): हिरण्यं कस्मात् ध्रियत आयम्यमानमिति ना क्रियते जनाज्जनं (*hiraṇyaṃ kasmāt dhriyata āyamyamānamiti nā kriyate janājjanaṃ*) (Ni. 2-10). पाणिः पणायतेः पूजाकर्मणः (*pāṇiḥ paṇāyateḥ pūjākarmaṇaḥ*) (Ni. 2-26).[?103]

श्लोकं आश्रेः— श्लोक्यते अनेनेति श्लोकः स्तोत्रं (*ślokaṃ āśreḥ— ślokyate aneneti ślokaḥ stotraṃ*). It is described that the god Savitṛ, having come to the sacrificial hall, may hear the praise recited by the Ṛtvijs.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सु॒कृत्सु॑पा॒णिः स्ववाँ॑ ऋ॒तावा॑ दे॒वस्त्वष्टाव॑से॒ तानि॑ नो धात् ।
पू॒ष॒ण्वन्त॑ ऋभवो मादयध्वमू॒र्ध्वग्रा॑वाणो अध्व॒रम॑तष्ट ॥ १२ ॥

> *sukṛtsupāṇiḥ svavā~ ṛtāvā devastvaṣṭāvase tāni no dhāt |*
> *pūṣaṇvanta ṛbhavo mādayadhvamūrdhvagrāvāṇo adhvaramataṣṭa* ‖ 12 ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> सुकृत् । सुपाणिः । स्ववान् । ऋतवा । देवः । त्वष्टा । अवसे । तानि । नः । धात् ।
> पूषण्वंतः । ऋभवः । मादयध्वं । ऊर्ध्वग्रावानः । अध्वरं । अतष्ट ॥ १२ ॥

> *sukṛt | supāṇiḥ | svavān | ṛtavā | devaḥ | tvaṣṭā | avase | tāni | naḥ | dhāt |*
> *pūṣaṇvaṃtaḥ | ṛbhavaḥ | mādayadhvaṃ | ūrdhvagrāvānaḥ | adhvaraṃ | ataṣṭa* ‖ 12 ‖

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सुकृत्सुष्टु जगतः कर्ता सुपाणिः कल्याणपाणिः स्ववान् धनवानृतावा सत्यसंकल्पस्वष्टा
> देवस्तानि यान्यस्माकमपेक्षितान्यवसे रक्षणाय नोऽस्मभ्यं धात् ।
> ददातु । ऋभवः । उरु भांतीत्यृभवः । हे ऋभवः पूषण्वंतः पूष्णा सहिता
> यूयं मादयध्वं । अस्मान् धनप्रदानेन हृष्टान् कुरुत । ऊर्ध्वग्रावाणः
> सोमाभिषवार्थमुद्यतग्रावाणः संत ऋत्विज इममस्मदीयमध्वरमतष्ट।अकुर्वन्॥
> अतष्ट । तक्ष त्वक्षू तनूकरणे । ऊदित्वादत्रेडभावः । झलो झलीति सिलोपः ।
> स्कोः संयोगाद्योरिति ककारलोपः । बहुवचनस्यैकवचनं छांदसं ॥

> *sukṛtsuṣṭu jagataḥ kartā supāṇiḥ kalyāṇapāṇiḥ svavān dhanavānṛtāvā satyasaṃkalpasvaṣṭā devastāni yānyasmākamapekṣitānyavase rakṣaṇāya no 'smabhyaṃ dhāt |*
> *dadātu | ṛbhavaḥ | uru bhāṃtītyṛbhavaḥ | he ṛbhavaḥ pūṣaṇvaṃtaḥ pūṣṇā sahitā*
> *yūyaṃ mādayadhvaṃ | asmān dhanapradānena hṛṣṭān kuruta | ūrdhvagrāvāṇaḥ*
> *somābhiṣavārthamudyatagrāvāṇaḥ saṃta ṛtvija imamasmadīyamadhvaramataṣṭa|akurvan‖*
> *ataṣṭa | takṣa tvakṣū tanūkaraṇe | ūditvādatreḍabhāvaḥ | jhalo jhalīti silopaḥ |*
> *skoḥ saṃyogādyoriti kakāralopaḥ | bahuvacanasyaikavacanaṃ chāṃdasaṃ ‖*

Summary

सुकृत् (*sukṛt*) is the good maker of the world; सुपाणिः (*supāṇiḥ*) is the one with auspicious hands; स्ववान् (*svavān*) is the wealthy one; ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*) is the one whose resolve is true. May the god Tvaṣṭṛ, such as this, grant us for our protection those things we desire. ऋभवः (*ṛbhavaḥ*): those who shine widely (uru bhāntī) are the Ṛbhus. O Ṛbhus, you who are accompanied by Pūṣan, gladden us, make us glad by giving wealth. ऊर्ध्वग्रावाणः (*ūrdhvagrāvāṇaḥ*): the priests, holding the pressing stones raised for pressing the Soma, have performed this sacrifice of ours. अतष्ट (*ataṣṭa*) means "they performed".

Word-to-word meaning

- सुकृत् (*sukṛt*)—the excellent performer of rites
- सुपाणिः (*supāṇiḥ*)—one with excellent hands
- स्ववान् (*svavān*)—the wealthy one
- ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*)—one of true resolve
- त्वष्टा देवः (*tvaṣṭā devaḥ*)—Tvaṣṭṛ, who is divine in nature
- तानि (*tāni*)—those things that are desired by us
- अवसे (*avase*)—for our protection
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- धात् (*dhāt*)—may he give

- ऋभवः (*ṛbhavaḥ*)—O Ṛbhus
- पूषण्वंतः (*pūṣaṇvaṃtaḥ*)—you who are united with the god Pūṣan
- मादयध्वं (*mādayadhvaṃ*)—gladden us
- ऊर्ध्वग्रावाणः (*ūrdhvagrāvāṇaḥ*)—priests who hold up the stones (to press the Soma juice)
- अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)—(our) sacrifice
- अतष्ट (*ataṣṭa*)—have accomplished

Gist

May Tvaṣṭṛ, the excellent performer of rites, the one with excellent hands, the wealthy one, the one of true resolve, divine in nature, give us for our protection the things we desire. O

Ṛbhus, you who are united with the god Pūṣan, gladden us. The priests, holding up the stones to crush and press out the Soma juices, have accomplished our sacrifice.

English translation

May the divine Twashtri, the able artificer, the dextrous-handed, the possessor of wealth, the observer of truth, bestow upon us those things (which are necessary) for our preservation : Ribhus, associated with Pushan, make us joyful, as they (the priests), with uplifted stones, prepare the sacred libation.

Special Topics

त्वष्टा देवः (*tvaṣṭā devaḥ*)—The god called Tvaṣṭṛ is the one who has fashioned the world beautifully and is skilled with his hands. Since this god is of true resolve and is wealthy, the yajamāna's wish is set forth openly: may he fulfil our desires for the protection of us, the yajamānas.

ऊर्ध्वग्रावाणः (*ūrdhvagrāvāṇaḥ*)—सोमाभिषवार्थमुद्यतग्रावाणः (*somābhiṣavārthamudyatagrāvāṇaḥ*). The priests hold stones raised in their hands in order to press the Soma juice. The prayer is described thus: the sacrifices having been completed, may the god called Pūṣan come with the Ṛbhus to the sacrificial hall, be satisfied by the offering of the oblations, and bestow wealth on the yajamānas.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि॒द्युद्र॑था म॒रुत॑ ऋष्टि॒मन्तो॑ दि॒वो मर्या॑ ऋ॒तजा॑ता
अ॒यास॑ः ।
सर॑स्वती शृणवन्यु॒ज्ञिया॑सो॒ धाता॑ र॒यिं स॒हवी॑रं तुरा
सः ॥ १३ ॥

> *vidyudrathā maruta ṛṣṭimanto divo maryā ṛtajātā ayāsaḥ |*
> *sarasvatī śṛṇavanyajñiyāso dhātā rayiṃ sahavīraṃ turāsaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विद्युत्ठरथाः । मरुतः । ऋष्टिमंतः । दिवः । मर्याः । ऋतजाताः । अयासः ।
> सरस्वती । शृणवन् । यज्ञियासः । धात । रयिं । सहवीरं । तुरासः ॥ १३ ॥

> *vidyutṭharathāḥ | marutaḥ | ṛṣṭimaṃtaḥ | divaḥ | maryāḥ | ṛtajātāḥ | ayāsaḥ |*
> *sarasvatī | śṛṇavan | yajñiyāsaḥ | dhāta | rayiṃ | sahavīraṃ | turāsaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विद्युद्रथा विद्योतमानरथोपेता ऋष्टिमंतो दीप्तिमंतः। ऋष्टिरायुधविशेषः । तद्वंतो वा दिवो द्योतमाना मर्याः शत्रूणां मारयितार ऋतजाता
> उदकाद्यज्ञाद्वा प्रादुर्भूताः । यद्वा । ऋतमुदकं जातं येभ्यस्ते ऋतजाताः।
> अयासः सततगमनशीला यज्ञियासो यज्ञार्हा मरुतः सरस्वती । गद्यपद्यरूपेण
> प्रसरणमस्या अस्तीति सरस्वती । वाग्देवता च । एते सर्वे देवा मदीयमिमं
> स्तोमं शृणवन् । शृण्वंतु । तुरासोऽस्माकं फलप्रदाने त्वरणयुक्ता हे मरुतः
> सहवीरं पुत्रसहितं रयिं धनंधात। अस्मभ्यं धत्त ॥ धात । दधातेर्लोटि बहुलं

> छंदसीति शवोलुक् । तप्तनप्तनथनाश्चेति तबादेशः पादादित्पादनिघातः । तपः
> पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । तुरासः । तुर त्वरणे । इगुपधलक्षणः कः ।
> आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः ॥

> *vidyudrathā vidyotamānarathopetā ṛṣṭimaṃto dīptimaṃtaḥ|*
> *ṛṣṭirāyudhaviśeṣaḥ | tadvaṃto vā divo dyotamānā maryāḥ śatrūṇāṃ*
> *mārayitāra ṛtajātā*
> *udakādyajñādvā prādurbhūtāḥ | yadvā | ṛtamudakaṃ jātaṃ yebhyaste*
> *ṛtajātāḥ|*
> *ayāsaḥ satatagamanaśīlā yajjiyāso yajñārhā marutaḥ sarasvatī |*
> *gadyapadyarūpeṇa*
> *prasaraṇamasyā astīti sarasvatī | vāgdevatā ca | ete sarvè devā*
> *madīyamimaṃ*
> *stomaṃ śṛṇavan | śṛṇvaṃtu | turāso 'smākaṃ phalapradāne*
> *tvaraṇayuktā he marutaḥ*
> *sahavīraṃ putrasahitaṃ rayiṃ dhanaṃdhāta| asmabhyaṃ dhatta ‖*
> *dhāta | dadhāterloṭi bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti śavoluk | taptanaptanathanāśceti tabādeśaḥ*
> *pādāditpādanighātaḥ | tapaḥ*
> *pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | turāsaḥ | tura tvaraṇe |*
> *igupadhalakṣaṇaḥ kaḥ | āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

विद्युद्रथा (*vidyudrathā*): the Maruts are furnished with shining chariots. ऋष्टिमंतः (*ṛṣṭimaṃtaḥ*): radiant; or ऋष्टि (*ṛṣṭi*) is a particular weapon and they possess it. दिवः (*divaḥ*): shining. मर्याः (*maryāḥ*): those who cause enemies to die. ऋतजाता (*ṛtajātā*): born from water or from sacrifice; or else, those from whom water (ṛtam) was born are ऋतजाताः (*ṛtajātāḥ*). अयासः (*ayāsaḥ*): those whose nature is constant movement. Yajjiyāsaḥ: the Maruts, worthy of sacrifice. सरस्वती (*sarasvatī*): she who has a flowing forth (prasaraṇa) in the forms of prose and verse; she is also the deity of speech. May all these gods hear this my praise (शृणवन् (*śṛṇavan*) = शृण्वंतु (*śṛṇvaṃtu*)). तुरासः (*turāsaḥ*): O Maruts, eager to grant us the fruit, give us wealth together with sons (सहवीरं (*sahavīraṃ*)); धात (*dhāta*) means "bestow on us".

Word-to-word meaning

- विद्युद्रथाः (*vidyudrathāḥ*)—those whose chariot is lightning (or those whose chariot shines like lightning)
- ऋष्टिमंतः (*ṛṣṭimaṃtaḥ*)—those who have brilliant weapons
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—the resplendent ones
- मर्याः (*maryāḥ*)—destroyers of enemies
- ऋतजाताः (*ṛtajātāḥ*)—those born from water
- आयासः (*āyāsaḥ*)—those of constant motion
- यज्ञियासः (*yajñiyāsaḥ*)—those worthy of sacrifice
- मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—the Marut deities
- सरस्वती (*sarasvatī*)—(and) the goddess of speech as well
- शृणवन् (*śṛṇavan*)—let (them) hear (our praises)
- तुरासः (*turāsaḥ*)—O Maruts, eager (to give us the fruit)
- सहवीरं (*sahavīraṃ*)—together with heroic sons
- रयिं (*rayiṃ*)—wealth
- धातं (*dhātaṃ*)—give us

Gist

May the Marut deities, whose chariots shine like lightning, who have brilliant weapons, who are resplendent, destroyers of enemies, born from water, of constant motion, worthy of sacrifice, and the goddess of speech as well, hear our praises. O Marut deities, eager to give us the fruit, give us wealth together with heroic sons.

English translation

May the Maruts, whose cars are the lightning, who are armed with spears, resplendent, destroyers of foes, from whom the waters proceed, (who are) unresting and adorable, and may Saraswati hear (my prayer); and may you (Maruts), speedy in your liberality, bestow (upon us) riches and good offspring.

Special Topics

मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—The Marut deities travel in a shining chariot. ऋष्टिमंतः (*ṛṣṭimaṃtaḥ*): they shine with radiance, or they hold the weapon called ऋष्टि (*ṛṣṭi*). ऋतजाताः (*ṛtajātāḥ*): born from water, or born from sacrifice, or the causes of the production of water. अयासः (*ayāsaḥ*): these Maruts are of a nature always to move about. The yajamānas' desired prayer is set forth: may they, together with the goddess of speech, who exists as the spreading forth of speech in prose and verse, hear the praises recited by the priests at our sacrifices; and since these Maruts are quick in granting the yajamānas' wishes, may they bestow sons and wealth on the yajamāna.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

विष्णुं॒ स्तोमा॑सः पुरुद॒स्मम॒र्का भग॑स्येव का॒रिणो॒ याम॑नि ग्मन् ।
उ॒रु॒क्र॒मः क॑कु॒हो यस्य॑ पू॒र्वीर्न म॑र्धन्ति युव॒तयो॒ जनि॑त्रीः ॥ १४ ॥

> *viṣṇuṃ stomāsaḥ purudasmamarkā bhagasyeva kāriṇo yāmani gman |*
> *urukramaḥ kakuho yasya pūrvīrna mardhanti yuvatayo janitrīḥ ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विष्णुं । स्तोमासः । पुरुदस्मं । अर्काः । भगस्य इव ! कारिणः । यामनि । ग्मन् ।
> उरुक्रमः । ककुहः । यस्य । पूर्वी न मर्धंति । युवतयः । जनित्री ॥ १४ ॥

> *viṣṇuṃ | stomāsaḥ | purudasmaṃ | arkāḥ | bhagasya iva ! kāriṇaḥ | yāmani | gman |*
> *urukramaḥ | kakuhaḥ | yasya | pūrvī na mardhaṃti | yuvatayaḥ | janitrī ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स्तोमासः । स्तूयंत विभिरिति स्तोमाः स्तोत्राणि । आर्का अर्चनीयानि शस्त्राणि च भगस्येव धनस्य कारणः कर्तृणीव स्थितानि तानि यामनि संततं प्रतायमानेऽस्मिन्यज्ञे पुरुदस्मं बहुकर्माणं । यद्वा । बहून् दस्यत्युपक्षपयतीति पुरुदस्मः । तं विष्णुं देवं ग्मन् । गच्छंतु । पूर्विर्बहो जनित्रीः सर्वस्य जनयित्र्यो युवतयः परस्परमसंकीर्णाः ककुहः । कं स्कुभंति विस्तारयंतीति

> ककुभो दिशः । यद्वा । ककुबुच्छ्यार्थः उच्छ्रता इव हि दिशो वृक्षाग्रेषूपलभ्यमानास्तिष्ठंति ।
> एता दिशो विष्णोराज्ञां न मर्धंति । न हिंसंति । स विष्णु–
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> *stomāsaḥ | stūyaṃta vibhiriti stomāḥ stotrāṇi | ārkā arcanīyāni*
> *śastrāṇi ca bhagasyeva dhanasya kāraṇaḥ kartṛṇīva sthitāni tāni yāmani*
> *saṃtataṃ pratāyamāne 'sminyajñè purudasmaṃ bahukarmāṇaṃ |*
> *yadvā | bahūn dasyatyupakṣapayatīti*
> *purudasmaḥ | taṃ viṣṇuṃ devaṃ gman | gacchaṃtu | pūrvirbaho*
> *janitrīḥ sarvasya janayitryo yuvatayaḥ parasparamasaṃkīrṇāḥ kakuhaḥ*
> *| kaṃ skubhaṃti vistārayaṃtīti*
> *kakubho diśaḥ | yadvā | kakubucchayārthaḥ ucchratā iva hi diśo*
> *vṛkṣāgreṣūpalabhyamānāstiṣṭhaṃti | etā diśo viṣṇorājñāṃ na*
> *mardhaṃti | na hiṃsaṃti | sa viṣṇu-*
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> रुरुक्रमः । उरुर्महान् क्रमः पादविक्षेपो यस्य सः । त्रिविक्रमावतार एकेनैव
> पादेन सर्वं जगदाक्रम्यातिष्ठत ॥ ग्मन् । गमेर्लुजि मंत्रे घसेत्यादिना चेर्लुक्
> ककुभः । पृषोदरादित्वाद्रूपस्वरसिद्धिः ॥

> *rurukramaḥ | ururmahān kramaḥ pādavikṣepo yasya saḥ |*
> *trivikramāvatāra ekenaiva*
> *pādena sarvaṃ jagadākramyātiṣṭhata ‖ gman | gamerluji maṃtre*
> *ghasetyādinā cerluk*
> *kakubhaḥ | pṛṣodarāditvādrūpasvarasiddhiḥ ‖*

Summary

स्तोमासः (*stomāsaḥ*): that by which one is praised are stomas, hymns of praise. आर्का (*ārkā*): adorable praises and śastras. Standing as if they were makers (कारिणः (*kāriṇaḥ*)) of भग (*bhaga*), wealth, let them go (ग्मन् (*gman*) = गच्छंतु (*gacchaṃtu*)) to the god Viṣṇu, पुरुदस्मं (*purudasmaṃ*) "of many works", in this sacrifice that is continuously extended (यामनि (*yāmani*)). Or else, he destroys (दस्यति (*dasyati*)) many, hence पुरुदस्मः (*purudasmaḥ*). पूर्वीः (*pūrvīḥ*): many; जनित्रीः (*janitrīḥ*): the producers of all; युवतयः (*yuvatayaḥ*): mutually unmixed; ककुहः (*kakuhaḥ*): the directions, for they spread out the sky. Or else kakubh has the sense of height: the directions stand as if raised up, seen at the tops of trees. These directions do not violate (न मर्धंति (*na mardhaṃti*) = न हिंसंति (*na hiṃsaṃti*)) the command of Viṣṇu. That Viṣṇu is

उरुक्रमः (*urukramaḥ*): उरु (*uru*) is great, क्रम (*krama*) the stride of his feet, he whose stride is great. In the Trivikrama incarnation he stood having pervaded the entire world with one single foot.

Word-to-word meaning

- स्तोमासः (*stomāsaḥ*)—our hymns of praise
- आर्काः (*ārkāḥ*)—the śastra-mantras worthy of worship
- भगस्येव कारिणिः (*bhagasyeva kāriṇiḥ*)—being the causes of our prosperity
- यामनि (*yāmani*)—in our sacrifice
- पुरुदंसं (*purudaṃsaṃ*)—the doer of many works
- विष्णुं (*viṣṇuṃ*)—Viṣṇu
- ग्मन् (*gman*)—let them reach
- पूर्वीः (*pūrvīḥ*)—the many
- जनित्रीः (*janitrīḥ*)—the cause of the world's origin
- युवतयः (*yuvatayaḥ*)—those that are separate
- ककुहः (*kakuhaḥ*)—the directions
- यस्य (*yasya*)—of which Viṣṇu (the command)
- न मर्धंति (*na mardhaṃti*)—they do not transgress (that Viṣṇu)
- उरुक्रमः (*urukramaḥ*)—has a wide stride

Gist

May our hymns of praise and the śastra-mantras worthy of worship, being the causes of our prosperity, reach in our sacrifice Viṣṇu, the doer of many works. That Viṣṇu, whose command the directions, many in number, the cause of the world's origin, each separate, do not transgress, has a wide stride.

English translation

May (our) praises and prayers, the causes of good fortune, attain at this sacrifice Vishnu, the object of many rites : he, the wide-stepping ; whose commands the many-blending regions of space, the generators (of all beings), do not disobey.

Special Topics

अर्काः (*arkāḥ*)—अर्चनीयानि शस्त्राणि च (*arcanīyāni śastrāṇi ca*). The Nirukta-author has stated the meaning of the word अर्क(*arka*) in four ways: mantra, deity, tree, food (Ni. 5-4). Here Sāyaṇa has said that the word is used in the sense of a mantra that praises the greatness of a deity.

पुरुदस्मं (*purudasmaṃ*)—बहुकर्माणं (*bahukarmāṇaṃ*); यद्वा बहून् दस्यति उपक्षपयति (*yadvā bahūn dasyati upakṣapayati*). For this word two meanings are explained: one who does many works, or one who destroys many enemies.

स्तोमासः अर्काः पुरुदस्मं ग्मन् (*stomāsaḥ arkāḥ purudasmaṃ gman*)—स्तोत्राणि शस्त्राणि च बहुकर्माणं तं देवं विष्णुं गच्छंतु (*stotrāṇi śastrāṇi ca bahukarmāṇaṃ taṃ devaṃ viṣṇuṃ gacchaṃtu*). It is explained that the hymns recited by the priests, which are the means of obtaining wealth, and the śastra-mantras, are also for winning the favour of Viṣṇu, who performs many works and

destroys many wicked ones.

ककुहः (*kakuhaḥ*)—"They expand the sky", that is, the directions make manifest the extent of the sky. Also: यद्वा ककुबुच्छयार्थः (*yadvā kakubucchayārthaḥ*), उच्च्रिता इव दिशः वृक्षाग्रेषूपलभ्यमानाः तिष्ठंति (*uccritā iva diśaḥ vṛkṣāgreṣūpalabhyamānāḥ tiṣṭhaṃti*): since the directions are lofty, as if connected with the tops of trees, the directions are high regions. Thus the meaning of the word kakup is set out.

पूर्वीः जनित्रीः ककुहः युवतयः विष्णोराज्ञां न मर्धंति (*pūrvīḥ janitrīḥ kakuhaḥ yuvatayaḥ viṣṇorājñāṃ na mardhaṃti*)—It is described that even these directions, many in number, producing everything, each separate, do not transgress the command of Viṣṇu, who is full of greatness. This Viṣṇu is उरुक्रमः (*urukramaḥ*)—उरुः महान् पादविक्षेपः यस्य सः (*uruḥ mahān pādavikṣepaḥ yasya saḥ*): one with a great placing of the feet. It is described that by a single placing of his foot he has pervaded the whole earth, and so the greatness of Viṣṇu is described as unsurpassed.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्रो॒ विश्वै॑र्वी॒र्यै॒३॒॑◌ः पत्य॑मान उ॒भे आ प॑प्रौ॒ रोद॑सी महि॒त्वा ।
पु॒रं॒द॒रो वृ॑त्र॒हा धृ॒ष्णुषे॑णः सं॒गृभ्या॑ न॒ आ भ॑रा॒ भूरि॑ प॒श्वः ॥ १५ ॥

> *indro viśvairvīryaiḥ patyamāna ubhe ā paprau rodasī mahitvā |*
> *puraṃdaro vṛtrahā dhṛṣṇuṣeṇaḥ saṃgṛbhyā na ā bharā bhūri paśvaḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रः । विश्वैः । वीर्य्यैः । पत्यमानः । उभे इति । आ । पप्रौ । रोदसी इति ।
> महित्वा ।
> पुरम्दरः । वृत्रहा । धृष्णुसेनः । समगृभ्य । नः । आ । भर । भूरि । पश्वः ॥१५॥

> *iṃdraḥ | viśvaiḥ | vīryyaiḥ | patyamānaḥ | ubhe iti | ā | paprau | rodasī iti |*
> *mahitvā |*
> *puramdaraḥ | vṛtrahā | dhṛṣṇusenaḥ | samagṛbhya | naḥ | ā | bhara | bhūri | paśvaḥ ‖15‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वैः सर्वीर्वैः सामर्थ्यैः पत्यमानः प्राप्यमाणः स इंद्र उभे रोदसी
> द्यावाप्पथिव्यौ महित्वा स्वकीयेन महिम्ना पप्रौ । पूरयामास । शेषः प्रत्यक्षकृतः ।

> *viśvaiḥ sarvīrvaiḥ sāmarthyaiḥ patyamānaḥ prāpyamāṇaḥ sa iṃdra ubhe rodasī*
> *dyāvāppathivyau mahitvā svakīyena mahimnā paprau | pūrayāmāsa | śeṣaḥ pratyakṣakṛtaḥ |*

> पुरंदरः शत्रुपुरां दारयिता वृत्रहा वृत्रस्य हंता धृष्णुषेणः पराभिभवनशीलसेनोपेतः स त्वं पश्वः पशून् संगृभ्य संगृह्य नोऽस्मभ्यं भूरि प्रभूतं यथा भवति
> तथा भर । देहि । यद्वा । पश्वः पशोर्भूरि बहुत्वं बहून् पशूंश्च यच्छेति ॥
> पुरंदरः । दृ विदारण इत्यस्य पुरशब्द उपपदे पूःसर्वयोर्दारिसहोरिति खच्प्रत्ययः । वाचंयमपुरंदरौ चेति निपातनात्पूर्वपदस्यामागमः । चित्तादंतोदात्तः। धृष्णुषेणः । पूर्वपदादिति संहितायां षत्वं । यदा षत्वं तदा रषाभ्यामिति
> णत्वं । संगृभ्य । ग्रहेल्यपि स्थानिवद्भावात्संप्रसारणं । हृग्रहोर्भश्छंदसीति भत्वं ।
> लितीति प्रत्ययात्पूर्वस्योदात्तत्वं । पश्वः । पशुशब्दात् शसः जसादिषु छंदसि वावचनमिति सवर्णदीर्घाभावः ॥

> *puraṃdaraḥ śatrupurāṃ dārayitā vṛtrahā vṛtrasya haṃtā dhṛṣṇuṣeṇaḥ parābhibhavanaśīlasenopetaḥ sa tvaṃ paśvaḥ paśūn saṃgṛbhya saṃgṛhya no 'smabhyaṃ bhūri prabhūtaṃ yathā bhavati*
> *tathā bhara | dehi | yadvā | paśvaḥ paśorbhūri bahutvaṃ bahūn paśūṃśca yaccheti ‖*
> *puraṃdaraḥ | dṛ vidāraṇa ityasya puraśabda upapade pūḥsarvayordārisahoriti khacpratyayaḥ | vācaṃyamapuraṃdarau ceti nipātanātpūrvapadasyāmāgamaḥ | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ| dhṛṣṇuṣeṇaḥ | pūrvapadāditi saṃhitāyāṃ ṣatvaṃ | yadā ṣatvaṃ tadā raṣābhyāmiti ṇatvaṃ | saṃgṛbhya | grahelyapi sthānivadbhāvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | hṛgrahorbhaścaṃdasīti bhatvaṃ |*
> *litīti pratyayātpūrvasyodāttatvaṃ | paśvaḥ | paśuśabdāt śasaḥ jasādiṣu chaṃdasi vāvacanamiti savarṇadīrghābhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

That Indra, who is attained (पत्यमानः (*patyamānaḥ*) = प्राप्यमाणः (*prāpyamāṇaḥ*)) by all powers (विश्वैः वीर्यैः (*viśvaiḥ vīryaiḥ*)), filled (पप्रौ (*paprau*) = पूरयामास (*pūrayāmāsa*)) both रोदसी (*rodasī*), heaven and earth, with his own greatness (महित्वा (*mahitvā*)). The rest is in the second person, as if before the eyes.

पुरंदरः (*puraṃdaraḥ*): the breaker of enemy cities; वृत्रहा (*vṛtrahā*): the slayer of Vṛtra; धृष्णुषेणः (*dhṛṣṇuṣeṇaḥ*): possessed of an army whose nature is to overpower others. You, such as this, having gathered (संगृभ्य (*saṃgṛbhya*) = संगृह्य (*saṃgṛhya*)) the cattle (पश्वः (*paśvaḥ*) = पशून् (*paśūn*)), bring (भर (*bhara*) = देहि (*dehi*)) them to us abundantly (भूरि (*bhūri*) = प्रभूतं (*prabhūtaṃ*)). Or else, भूरि (*bhūri*) means plurality: give many cattle.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वैः (*viśvaiḥ*)—all
- वीर्यैः (*vīryaiḥ*)—by powers
- पत्यमानः (*patyamānaḥ*)—united
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- उभे रोदसी (*ubhe rodasī*)—both heaven and earth
- महित्वा (*mahitvā*)—by his greatness
- आ पप्रौ (*ā paprau*)—has filled (O Indra)
- पुरंदरः (*puraṃdaraḥ*)—the destroyer of enemy cities
- वृत्रहा (*vṛtrahā*)—the slayer of Vṛtra
- धृष्णुषेणः (*dhṛṣṇuṣeṇaḥ*)—you who have an army that destroys enemies
- पश्वः (*paśvaḥ*)—cattle
- संगृह्य (*saṃgṛhya*)—having gathered
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—so as to be abundant
- आ भर (*ā bhara*)—provide

Gist

Indra, united with all powers, has filled both heaven and earth with his greatness. O Indra, you, the destroyer of enemy cities, the slayer of Vṛtra, who have an army that destroys enemies, gather cattle in abundance and give them to us.

English translation

Indra, invested with all energies, has filled both heaven and earth with his greatness : you are the destroyer of cities, the slayer of Vritra, the leader of a conquering host, collect cattle and bestow them abundantly upon us.

Special Topics

इंद्रः विश्वैः वीर्यैः पत्यमानः (*iṃdraḥ viśvaiḥ vīryaiḥ patyamānaḥ*)—सर्वैः सामर्थ्य्यैः प्राप्यमाणः इंद्रः (*sarvaiḥ sāmarthyyaiḥ prāpyamāṇaḥ iṃdraḥ*). The meaning of the word इंद्र (*iṃdra*) is explained in various ways by Yāska (Ni. 10-8). It is described that Indra, being full of manifold and complete power, has filled heaven and earth with his greatness.

Indra, the slayer of Vṛtra, endowed with an army bent on overcoming foes, is prayed to bring plenty of cattle to us, the sacrificers. The Sanskrit of this prayer is वृत्रहा धृष्णुसेनः नः पश्वः भूरि आ भर (*vṛtrahā dhṛṣṇusenaḥ naḥ paśvaḥ bhūri ā bhara*)—पराभिभवनशीलसेनोपेतः वृत्रस्य हंता अस्मभ्यं पशून् भूरि यथा भवति तथा आभर । (*parābhibhavanaśīlasenopetaḥ vṛtrasya haṃtā asmabhyaṃ paśūn bhūri yathā bhavati tathā ābhara* |), and alternatively यद्वा पशोः भूरि बर्हू पशूंश्च यच्छ (*yadvā paśoḥ bhūri barhū paśūṃśca yaccha*). In Kannada: may Indra, the slayer of Vṛtra, accompanied by armies able to defeat enemies, graciously grant us, the sacrificers, many animals such as cows, so that they gather to us in plenty; or may he grant plentiful animals alone. Such is the prayer expressed.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नास॑त्या मे पि॒तरा॑ बन्धु॒पृच्छा॑ सजा॒त्य॑म॒श्विनो॒श्चारु॒ नाम॑ ।
यु॒वं हि स्थो र॑यि॒दौ नो॑ रयी॒णां दा॒त्रं र॑क्षेथे॒ अक॑वै॒रद॑ब्धा ॥ १६ ॥

> *nāsatyā me pitarā bandhupṛcchā sajātyamaśvinoścāru nāma |*
> *yuvaṃ hi stho rayidau no rayīṇāṃ dātraṃ rakṣethe akavairadabdhā ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नासत्या । मे । पितरा । बंधुपृच्छा । सजात्यं । अश्विनोः । चारु । नाम ।
> युवं । हि । स्थः । रयिद्दौ । नः । रयीणां । दात्रं । रक्षेथे इति । अकवैः । अदद्दा ॥

> *nāsatyā | me | pitarā | baṃdhupṛcchā | sajātyaṃ | aśvinoḥ | cāru | nāma |*
> *yuvaṃ | hi | sthaḥ | rayiddau | naḥ | rayīṇāṃ | dātraṃ | rakṣethe iti | akavaiḥ | adaddā ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे नासत्यावश्विन् बंधुपृच्छा । हविष्पदातृत्वेन बंधूनस्मानपेक्षितमर्थं
> पृच्छत इति बंधूनां प्रष्टारौ । युवां मे पितरौ पालयितारौ भवतं । युवयोरश्विनोः सजात्यं
> सजाते भवं संगतं चारु नाम कमनीयं खलु । हे अश्विनौ
> युवं युवां नोऽस्मभ्यं रयीणां धनानां मध्ये रयिदावुत्तमस्य धनस्य
> दातारौ स्थो हि । भवथः खलु। किंच आदब्बा केनाप्यतिरस्कृतौ युवां दात्रं हविषां
> दातारं मामकवैरकुत्सितैः शोभनैः कर्मभी रक्षेथे । पालयतं ॥ नासत्या ।
> नभ्राण्नपादित्यादिना निपातनान्नञ्ञः प्रकृतिभावः । बंधुपृच्छा । पृच्छेः क्विप् । सुपां
> सुलुगिति सुपो डादेशः । सजात्यं । सजाते भवं । भवे छंदसीति यत् । तित्स्वरितः ।
> स्थः । अस्तेर्लट रूपं । हियोगादनिघातः ॥

> *he nāsatyāvaśvin baṃdhupṛcchā | haviṣpadātṛtvena baṃdhūnasmānapekṣitamarthaṃ*
> *pṛcchata iti baṃdhūnāṃ praṣṭārau | yuvāṃ me pitarau pālayitārau bhavataṃ | yuvayoraśvinoḥ sajātyaṃ sajāte bhavaṃ saṃgataṃ cāru nāma kamanīyaṃ khalu | he aśvinau*
> *yuvaṃ yuvāṃ no 'smabhyaṃ rayīṇāṃ dhanānāṃ madhyè rayidāvuttamasya dhanasya*
> *dātārau stho hi | bhavathaḥ khalu| kiṃca ādabbā kenāpyatiraskṛtau yuvāṃ dātraṃ haviṣāṃ*
> *dātāraṃ māmakavairakutsitaiḥ śobhanaiḥ karmabhī rakṣethe | pālayataṃ ‖ nāsatyā | nabhrāṇnapādityādinā nipātanānnaññaḥ prakṛtibhāvaḥ | baṃdhupṛcchā | pṛccheḥ kvip | supāṃ*

> *sulugiti supo ḍādeśaḥ | sajātyaṃ | sajāte bhavaṃ | bhave chaṃdasīti yat | titsvaritaḥ |*
> *sthaḥ | asterlaṭa rūpaṃ | hiyogādanighātaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Nāsatyas, Aśvins, bandhupṛcchā": since by giving oblations we are their kinsmen, they ask us the object we desire, and so are "questioners of kinsmen". "You two are my parents", my protectors. This "common-birth" (सजात्यं (*sajātyaṃ*), what exists in the same birth, conjoined) of you two Aśvins is a lovely name. "O Aśvins, you are the givers to us of the best wealth among riches (रयिदौ (*rayidau*))". Further, unbaffled by anyone, you two protect me, the giver of the oblations, with good deeds that are blameless (अकवैः (*akavaiḥ*) = अकुत्सितैः (*akutsitaiḥ*), the unblameable). Protect me.

Word-to-word meaning

- नासत्या (*nāsatyā*)—O Aśvin gods
- बंधुपृच्छा (*baṃdhupṛcchā*)—you who, being kinsmen to us, ask and learn our desired objects
- मे (*me*)—to me
- पितरा (*pitarā*)—be protectors
- अश्विनोः (*aśvinoḥ*)—of you two
- सजात्यं (*sajātyaṃ*)—being one together
- चारु नाम (*cāru nāma*)—is attractive
- युवं (*yuvaṃ*)—you two
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- रयीणां (*rayīṇāṃ*)—among the whole group of riches
- रयिदौ (*rayidau*)—as givers of the best wealth
- स्थः हि (*sthaḥ hi*)—are you not
- अदब्धा (*adabdhā*)—you who are not harmed by others
- दात्रं (*dātraṃ*)—me, who offer the oblation
- अकवैः (*akavaiḥ*)—with good deeds
- रक्षेथे (*rakṣethe*)—protect

Gist

O Aśvin gods, you who, being kinsmen to us, ask and learn our desired objects, be protectors to me. Your being joined together is attractive to the sight. You are the givers to us of the best wealth among all wealth. You, who are not harmed by others, protect me, the offerer of the oblation, with good deeds.

English translation

Nasatyas, my protectors, inquirers (after the wishes) of your kinsman, beautiful is your cognate appellation of Ashwins ; be to us the liberal donors of riches : you, are irresistible, protect the offer (of the oblation) with unblameable (defences).

Special Topics

नासत्या बंधुपृच्छा मे पितरौ (*nāsatyā baṃdhupṛcchā me pitarau*)—अश्विनौ हविस्पदातृत्वेन बंधूनस्मान् अपे क्षितमर्थं पृच्छतः युवां पालयितारौ भवतं । (*aśvinau havispadātṛtvena baṃdhūnasmān ape kṣitamarthaṃ pṛcchataḥ yuvāṃ pālayitārau bhavataṃ* |). The word Nāsatyau is explained by Yāska (Ni. 6-13) in two or three ways. The Aśvin gods, as kinsmen would inquire, inquire into and learn the wishes of the sacrificers who please them with offerings of oblations, and fulfil them; therefore the prayer is explained as asking that they be protectors of the sacrificers.

रयिदौ नो रयीणां (*rayidau no rayīṇāṃ*)—धनानां मध्ये उत्तमस्य धनस्य दातारौ (*dhanānāṃ madhye uttamasya dhanasya dātārau*): the meaning is described that among the various kinds of wealth the Aśvin gods grant the sacrificer the best wealth.

अदब्धा (*adabdhā*)—केनाप्यहिंसितौ (*kenāpyahiṃsitau*): it is declared that the Aśvin gods are those who are harmed by no one; and अकवैः रक्षेथे (*akavaiḥ rakṣethe*)—अकुत्सितैः शोभनकर्मभिः पालयितं (*akutsitaiḥ śobhanakarmabhiḥ pālayitaṃ*): that they should protect the sacrificers so that good rites, not open to blame, are performed continually.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हत्तद्व॑ः क॒वय॒श्चारु॒ नाम॒ यद्ध॑ देवा॒ भव॑थ॒ विश्व॒ इन्द्रे॑ ।
सख॑ ऋ॒भुभि॑ः पुरुहूत प्रि॒येभि॑रि॒मां धियं॑ सा॒तये॑ तक्षता नः ॥ १७ ॥

> *mahattadvaḥ kavayaścāru nāma yaddha devā bhavatha viśva indre |*
> *sakha ṛbhubhiḥ puruhūta priyebhirimāṃ dhiyaṃ sātaye takṣatā naḥ ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महत् । तत् । वः । कवयः । चारु । नाम । यत् । ह । देवाः । भवथ । विश्वे ।
> इंद्रे ।
> सखा । ऋभुभिः । पुरुहूत । प्रियेभिः । इमां । धियं । सातये । तक्षत । नः ॥
> ॥ १७ ॥

> *mahat | tat | vaḥ | kavayaḥ | cāru | nāma | yat | ha | devāḥ | bhavatha | viśve |*
> *iṃdre |*
> *sakhā | ṛbhubhiḥ | puruhūta | priyebhiḥ | imāṃ | dhiyaṃ | sātaye | takṣata | naḥ ‖*
> *‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे कवयो मेधाविनो हे देवा वो युष्माकं तत्तादृशं महत्पभूतं नाम कर्म नमनं वा चारु मनोहरं खलु । यद्येन कर्मणा विश्वे सर्वे यूयमिंद्र इंद्रोपलक्षिते लोके देवा भवथ ह देवत्वं प्राप्नुथ खलु । हे पुरुहूत बहुभिराहूत हे इंद्र त्वं प्रियेभिः प्रियतमैर्यभुभिः । ऋतेन भवंत्यृतेन भांतीति वा । ऋभभिर्देवैः सखासि । इंद्रसहिता ऋभवो यूयमिमामस्यदीयां धियं स्तुतिं नोऽस्माकं सातये धनादिलाभार्थं तक्षत । स्वीकुरुत ॥ यत् ।
> सुपां सुलुगित्यादिना सुपो लुक् । भवथ ॥ भवतेर्लटि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । सख ऋभुभिरित्यस्य संहितायामृत्यक इति प्रकृतिभावो ह्रस्वत्वं च ॥

> *he kavayo medhāvino he devā vo yuṣmākaṃ tattādṛśaṃ mahatpabhūtaṃ nāma karma namanaṃ vā cāru manoharaṃ khalu | yadyena karmaṇā viśve sarvè*
> *yūyamiṃdra iṃdropalakṣite loke devā bhavatha ha devatvaṃ prāpnutha khalu | he*
> *puruhūta bahubhirāhūta he iṃdra tvaṃ priyebhiḥ priyatamairyabhubhiḥ | ṛtena bhavaṃtyṛtena bhāṃtīti vā | ṛbhabhirdevaiḥ sakhāsi | iṃdrasahitā ṛbhavo yūyamimāmasyadīyāṃ dhiyaṃ stutiṃ no 'smākaṃ sātaye dhanādilābhārthaṃ takṣata | svīkuruta || yat | supāṃ sulugityādinā supo luk | bhavatha || bhavaterlaṭi rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | sakha ṛbhubhirityasya saṃhitāyāmṛtyaka iti prakṛtibhāvo hrasvatvaṃ ca ||*

Summary

"O wise ones (कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)), O gods, that great, abundant नाम (*nāma*)—either 'action' or 'bowing'—of yours is surely charming; by which action all of you attain godhood in the world marked by Indra." "O Indra, invoked by many, you are a friend with the Ribhus, your dearest." The Ribhus are explained as those who come into being by ṛta (truth, order), or who shine by ṛta. "You Ribhus, together with Indra, accept (तक्षत (*takṣata*), 'receive') this praise of his for our gain of wealth and the like."

Word-to-word meaning

- कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)—O wise gods
- वः (*vaḥ*)—to you
- तत् (*tat*)—that well-known
- महत् (*mahat*)—and abundant
- नाम (*nāma*)—action
- चारु (*cāru*)—is dear
- यत् (*yat*)—by which very action
- विश्वे (*viśve*)—all of you together
- इंद्रे (*iṃdre*)—in Indra's world
- देवाः भवथ ह (*devāḥ bhavatha ha*)—have you not attained godhood
- पुरुहूत (*puruhūta*)—O Indra, invoked by many

- प्रियेभिः (*priyebhiḥ*)—who are dearest to you
- ऋभुभिः (*ṛbhubhiḥ*)—with the Ribhus
- सखा (*sakhā*)—you are a friend
- इमां (*imāṃ*)—offered by us
- धियं (*dhiyaṃ*)—the praise
- नः (*naḥ*)—for us
- सातेये (*sātèye*)—for the gain of wealth
- तक्षत (*takṣata*)—accept

Gist

O wise gods, the well-known and abundant action is dear to you. By that very action have you all not attained godhood in Indra's world? O Indra, invoked by many, you are a friend with the Ribhus, who are dearest to you. Accept the praise offered by us for the gain of wealth for us.

English translation

Sages acquainted with the past, excellent is that beautiful appellation under which you have both become gods in (the sphere of) Indra : Indra, the invoked of many, a friend, (associated) with the beloved Ribhus, shape this prayer for our benefit.

Special Topics

कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)—मेधा विनः (*medhā vinaḥ*). The word kavi is stated among the names of the wise (Ni. 3-19). By this word the gods are addressed as being wise. Of these gods महत् नमनं चारु (*mahat namanaṃ cāru*)—प्रभूतं नमनं मनोहरं (*prabhūtaṃ namanaṃ manoharaṃ*): it is described that their excessive performance of deeds is beneficial to the world and attractive to the minds of all.

And यत् विश्वे इंद्रे देवाः भवथ (*yat viśve iṃdre devāḥ bhavatha*)—येन कर्मणा सर्वे यूयं इंद्रो सलक्षिते लोकेदेवत्वं प्राप्नुथ । (*yena karmaṇā sarvè yūyaṃ iṃdro salakṣite loke devatvaṃ prāpnutha* |). Their excellent performance of rites is praised thus: by the rites these gods perform, they obtain a shining godhood and dwell in the world where Indra dwells.

Although Indra is addressed by the word purūhūta, it is declared that this Indra is a friend of the gods called Ribhus, and that the Ribhus, coming with Indra to the sacrificial hall and hearing the sacrificer's praises, should grant wealth and the like to the sacrificer.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒र्य॒मा णो॒ अदि॑तिर्य॒ज्ञिया॒सोऽद॑ब्धानि॒ वरु॑णस्य व्र॒तानि॑ ।
यु॒योत॑ नो अन॒प॒त्यानि॒ गन्तो॑ः प्र॒जावा॑न्नः पशु॒माँ अ॑स्तु गा॒तुः ॥ १८ ॥

> *aryamā ṇo aditiryajñiyāso 'dabdhāni varuṇasya vratāni |*
> *yuyota no anapatyāni gantoḥ prajāvānnaḥ paśumā~ astu gātuḥ ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आर्यमा । नः । अदितिः । यज्ञियासः । आदब्बानि । वरुणस्य । व्रतानि ।
> युयोत । नः । अनपत्यानि । गंतोः । प्रजावान् । नः । पशुमान् । अस्तु । गातुः॥

> *āryamā | naḥ | aditiḥ | yajñiyāsaḥ | ādabbāni | varuṇasya | vratāni |*
> *yuyota | naḥ | anapatyāni | gaṃtoḥ | prajāvān | naḥ | paśumān | astu | gātuḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अर्यमा । ऋच्छति सर्वदा गच्छतीत्यर्यमा सूर्यः । आदितिर्देवमाता यज्ञियासो यज्ञार्हा देवा यस्य वरुणस्य व्रतानि कर्माण्यदब्बान्यहिंसितानि भवंति स वरुणस्ते चार्यमादयो देवा नोऽस्मानक्षंत्विति शेषः । ते यूयं नोऽस्माकमनपत्यान्यपत्यानां पुत्राणामहितानि कर्माणि । यद्वा । पतनकारणं न भवतीत्यपत्यं । तदन्यान्यनपत्यानि पतनकारणानि कर्माणि गंतोः सन्मार्गाद्युयोत। पृथक्कुरुत । यथा तान्यहितानि कर्माणि न स्पृशंति तथा कुरुतेत्यर्थः । अथ गातुः । गायंति स्तुवंतींद्रादीनत्रेति गातुर्गृहं । नोऽस्मदीयं गृहं पशुमान्पश्वादियुक्तं प्रजावानपत्योपेशमस्तु ॥ आर्यमा । ऋ गत् । श्वन्नु क्षन्निहन्नेदन्नित्यादिना निपातनाद्रूपसिद्धिः । अदितिः । दीज् क्षय इत्यस्य कर्तरि क्तिच् । नञा समासः ।

> अदितिरदीनेति यास्कः । छांदसं ह्रस्वत्वं । नञा: स्वरः । युयोत । यौतेरमिश्रीभावकर्मणो
> लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति शप श्लुः । तप्तनबिति तप्रत्ययस्य तबादेशः ।
> गंतोः । गम्ल गत् । सितनिगमिमसिसच्यविधाण्क्रुशिभ्य इति तुन्प्रत्ययः । नित्तादाम्युदात्तः
> । गातुः । गापाहिभ्यश्चेति तुप्रत्ययः ॥

> *aryamā | ṛcchati sarvadā gacchatītyaryamā sūryaḥ | āditirdevamātā*
> *yajjiyāso yajñārhā devā yasya varuṇasya vratāni*
> *karmāṇyadabbānyahiṃsitāni*
> *bhavaṃti sa varuṇaste cāryamādayo devā no 'smānakṣaṃtviti śeṣaḥ | te yūyaṃ*
> *no 'smākamanapatyānyapatyānāṃ putrāṇāmahitāni karmāṇi | yadvā | patanakāraṇaṃ na*
> *bhavatītyapatyaṃ | tadanyānyanapatyāni patanakāraṇāni karmāṇi gaṃtoḥ sanmārgādyuyota|*
> *pṛthakkuruta | yathā tānyahitāni karmāṇi na spṛśaṃti tathā kurutetyarthaḥ | atha gātuḥ |*
> *gāyaṃti stuvaṃtīṃdrādīnatreti gāturgṛhaṃ | no 'smadīyaṃ gṛhaṃ*
> *paśumānpaśvādiyuktaṃ prajāvānapatyopeśamastu ‖ āryamā | ṛ gat |*
> *śvannu kṣannihannedannityādinā nipātanādrūpasiddhiḥ | aditiḥ | dīj*
> *kṣaya ityasya kartari ktic | nañā samāsaḥ |*
> *aditiradīneti yāskaḥ | chāṃdasaṃ hrasvatvaṃ | nañā: svaraḥ | yuyota |*
> *yauteramiśrībhāvakarmaṇo loṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapa śluḥ |*
> *taptanabiti tapratyayasya tabādeśaḥ |*
> *gaṃtoḥ | gamla gat | sitanigamimasisacyavidhāṇkruśibhya iti*
> *tunpratyayaḥ | nittādāmyudāttaḥ | gātuḥ | gāpāhibhyaśceti tupratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

Aryaman: "he goes (ऋच्छति (*ṛcchati*)) always", hence Aryaman, the Sun. Aditi is the mother of the gods. यज्ञियासो (*yajjiyāso*) are the gods worthy of sacrifice. Varuṇa's व्रतानि (*vratāni*), his works, are unharmed (adabbāni = ahiṃsitāni). That Varuṇa and those gods, Aryaman and the rest, "may protect us" (the verb to be supplied). You, as to us: अनपत्यानि (*anapatyāni*) are deeds that are not beneficial to अपत्यानां (*apatyānāṃ*), sons. Or else: what is not a cause of falling is apatya; the others, अनपत्यानि (*anapatyāni*), are deeds that are causes of falling. Separate us (युयोत (*yuyota*)) from these, from the right path (गंतोः

(*gaṃtoḥ*)): act so that those harmful deeds do not touch us. Then गातुः (*gātuḥ*): people sing, praise Indra and the others here, hence गातुः (*gātuḥ*) is the house. May our house be पशुमान् (*paśumān*), furnished with cattle and the like, and प्रजावान् (*prajāvān*), possessed of offspring.

Word-to-word meaning

- अरमा (*aramā*)—Aryaman, the god[?104]
- अदितिः (*aditiḥ*)—Aditi, mother of the gods
- यज्ञियासः (*yajñiyāsaḥ*)—the gods worthy of sacrifice
- वरुणस्य (*varuṇasya*)—of Varuṇa
- व्रतानि (*vratāni*)—the works
- आदब्बानि (*ādabbāni*)—being unharmed
- नः (*naḥ*)—may they protect us
- अनपत्यानि (*anapatyāni*)—deeds opposed to offspring
- गंतोः (*gaṃtoḥ*)—than the right path[?105]
- युयोत (*yuyota*)—let them separate (let them make us not enter the wrong path)
- नः (*naḥ*)—our house
- पशुमान् (*paśumān*)—furnished with cattle and the like
- प्रजावान् (*prajāvān*)—possessed of progeny
- अस्तु (*astu*)—let it be

Gist

May Aryaman, Aditi the mother of the gods, the gods worthy of sacrifice, and the works of Varuṇa too, being unharmed, protect us. Destroying the deeds opposed to our offspring, let them keep us always on the right path. May our house be furnished with cattle and the like, and possessed of progeny.

English translation

May Aryaman, Aditi the adorable (gods), and the unimpeded functions of Varuna (protect) us : keep us from (following) the course unpro- pitious to offspring, and may our dwelling be abundant in progeny and cattle.

Special Topics

आर्यमा (*āryamā*)—ऋच्छति सर्वदा गच्छतीत्यर्यमा सूर्यः (*ṛcchati sarvadā gacchatītyaryamā sūryaḥ*). Sāyaṇa explains that the Sun is designated by the word Aryaman because he is always in motion. The explanation of Durgācārya is अरीणां तमसां नियंता (*arīṇāṃ tamasāṃ niyaṃtā*) (Ni. 11-24). Various meanings of the word Aditi are explained by Yāska. Here the word is used in the sense "mother of the gods". Because the works of the goddess Aditi, mother of the gods, of the Sun, of Varuṇa and of the gods worthy of sacrifice cause harm to no one, the prayer is made that these gods protect us, the sacrificers.

For the word अनपत्यानि (*anapatyāni*): अपत्यानां पुत्राणामहितानि कर्माणि (*apatyānāṃ putrāṇāmahitāni karmāṇi*)—deeds not beneficial to sons; and else, पतनकारणं न भवतीतपत्यं तदन्यान्यनपत्यानि पतन कारणानि कर्माणि (*patanakāraṇaṃ na bhavatītapatyaṃ tadanyānyanapatyāni patana kāraṇāni karmāṇi*)—or else, deeds that are not a cause of falling are अपत्य (*apatya*); deeds other than these are अनपत्य (*anapatya*) and are therefore known as causes of falling. नः गंतोः युयोत (*naḥ gaṃtoḥ yuyota*): it is wished that these gods grant that deeds not beneficial to the sacrificers' sons do not occur, or that they keep away from the proper path the deeds that cause the sacrificers' fall.

गातुः (*gātuḥ*)—गायंत्यत्रेंद्रादीनिति गातुर्गृहं (*gāyaṃtyatreṃdrādīniti gāturgṛhaṃ*). The sacrificial hall, where Indra and the others are praised, is designated by the word गातुः (*gātuḥ*). The favour of these gods is wished for, that the sacrificer's house be filled with cattle and offspring.

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

दे॒वानां॑ दू॒तः पु॑रु॒ध प्रसू॒तोऽना॑गान्नो वोचतु स॒र्वता॑ता ।
शृ॒णोतु॑ नः पृथि॒वी द्यौरु॒ताप॒ः सूर्यो॒ नक्ष॑त्रैरु॒र्व१॑न्तरि॑क्षम् ॥ १९ ॥

> *devānāṃ dūtaḥ purudha prasūto 'nāgānno vocatu sarvatātā |*
> *śṛṇotu naḥ pṛthivī dyaurutāpaḥ sūryo nakṣatrairurvantarikṣam ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> देवानां । दूतः । पुरुध । प्रसूतः । अनागान् । नः । वोचतु । सर्वताता ।
> शृणोतु । नः । पृथिवी । द्यौः । उत । अपः । सूर्यैः । नक्षत्रैः । उरु । अंतरिक्षं ॥

> *devānāṃ | dūtaḥ | purudha | prasūtaḥ | anāgān | naḥ | vocatu | sarvatātā |*
> *śṛṇotu | naḥ | pṛthivī | dyauḥ | uta | apaḥ | sūryaiḥ | nakṣatraiḥ | uru | aṃtarikṣaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पुरुध पुरुषु बहुषु देशेषु प्रसूतोऽग्निहोत्रार्थं विहितः । यद्वा ।
> पुरुभिर्यजमानैः प्रसूतो यष्टव्यदेवाह्वानार्थं प्रेरितो देवानां दूतः ।
> तथा च तैत्तिरीयकं । अग्निर्देवानां दूत आसीदिति । तादृशोऽग्निः कर्मकर्तृसाधनवैगुण्येन
> सापराधानप्यस्माननागाननागसः । सर्वताता सर्वत्र वोचतु । ब्रवीतु ।
> किंच पृथिवी द्यौश्च उतापि चापः सूर्यश्च नक्षत्रैरुरु विस्तीर्णमंतरिक्षं च । एते
> सर्वे देवा नोऽस्मदीयां स्तुतिं शृणोतु । शृण्वंतु । प्रत्येकविवक्षयैकवचनं ॥
> प्रसूतः । षू प्रेरणे । कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरः । अनागान् ।
> शसि सकारलोपश्कांदसः । सवर्णदीर्घे कृते तस्माच्छसो न इति नत्वं । वोचतु ।
> वच परिभाषणे । व्यत्ययो बहुलमिति शपोऽजादेशः । वच उम् । गुणः । निघातः ।
> नक्षत्रैः । नक्ष गत् । अमिनक्षियजिबंधिपतिभ्योऽत्रन्नित्यत्रन्प्रत्ययः । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । यद्वा ।
> न क्षरति न क्षेयत इति वा नक्षत्रं । नभ्राण्णपादिति नञः प्रकृतिभावः ।
> नञः स्वरः ॥

> *purudha puruṣu bahuṣu deśeṣu prasūto 'gnihotrārthaṃ vihitaḥ | yadvā | purubhiryajamānaiḥ prasūto yaṣṭavyadevāhvānārthaṃ prerito devānāṃ dūtaḥ |*
> *tathā ca taittirīyakaṃ | agnirdèvānāṃ dūta āsīditi | tādṛśo 'gniḥ karmakartṛsādhanavaiguṇyena sāparādhānapyasmānanāgānanāgasaḥ | sarvatātā sarvatra vocatu | bravītu |*
> *kiṃca pṛthivī dyauśca utāpi cāpaḥ sūryaśca nakṣatrairuru vistīrṇamamaṃtarikṣaṃ ca | ete*
> *sarve devā no 'smadīyāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇotu | śṛṇvaṃtu | pratyekavivakṣayaikavacanaṃ ‖*
> *prasūtaḥ | ṣū preraṇe | karmaṇi ktaḥ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ prakṛtisvaraḥ | anāgān |*
> *śasi sakāralopaśkāṃdasaḥ | savarṇadīrghe kṛte tasmācchaso na iti natvaṃ | vocatu |*
> *vaca paribhāṣaṇe | vyatyayo bahulamiti śapo 'jādeśaḥ | vaca um | guṇaḥ | nighātaḥ |*
> *nakṣatraiḥ | nakṣa gat | aminakṣiyajibaṃdhipatibhyo 'trannityatranpratyayaḥ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ | yadvā | na kṣarati na kṣeyata iti vā nakṣatraṃ | nabhrāṇṇapāditi nañaḥ prakṛtibhāvaḥ | nañaḥ svaraḥ ‖*

Summary

पुरुध (*purudha*): प्रसूतः (*prasūtaḥ*) in many places (पुरुषु बहुषु देशेषु (*puruṣu bahuṣu deśeṣu*)), that is, appointed for the Agnihotra. Or else, impelled by many sacrificers to invite the gods to be sacrificed to, he is the messenger of the gods. So the Taittirīya text says अग्निर्देवानां दूत आसीदिति (*agnirdèvānāṃ dūta āsīditi*). May such an Agni, even though we are at fault through defects in the rite, the performer and the means, declare us everywhere (सर्वताता (*sarvatātā*)) to be अनागान् (*anāgān*), sinless; वोचतु (*vocatu*) means "let him say". Further: Earth and Heaven, and the Waters, the Sun, and the wide atmosphere with its stars—may all these gods hear our praise. The singular verb is used because each is intended separately.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुध (*purudha*)—in many regions

- प्रसूतः (*prasūtaḥ*)—produced (for the sacrifice)
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—to the gods
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—the messenger; Agni
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- अनागान् (*anāgān*)—as sinless
- सर्वताता (*sarvatātā*)—in all places
- वोचतु (*vocatu*)—let him proclaim
- पृथिवी (*pṛthivī*)—Earth
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)—the world of heaven
- उत (*uta*)—and
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the deity of the waters
- सूर्यः (*sūryaḥ*)—the Sun[?106]
- नक्षत्रैः (*nakṣatraiḥ*)—existing together with the stars
- उरु (*uru*)—extensive
- अंतरिक्षं (*aṃtarikṣaṃ*)—the atmosphere
- नः (*naḥ*)—our praise
- शृणोतु (*śṛṇotu*)—let it hear

Gist

May Agni, who is produced for the sacrifice in many regions and is the messenger of the gods, proclaim us everywhere as sinless. May the earth, the world of heaven, and the water-dei

…and the vast firmament together with the stars, the sun and the deity of the waters, shall also hear our praise.

English translation

May the messenger of the gods, engendered in many places, everywhere proclaim us void of offence : may earth and heaven, the waters, the sun, and the vast firmament, with the constellations, here us.

Special Topics

पुरुध प्रसूतः (*purudha prasūtaḥ*)—पुरुषु बहुषु देशेषु अग्निहोत्रार्थं विहितः (*puruṣu bahuṣu deśeṣu agnihotrārthaṃ vihitaḥ*) । Or else: पुरुभिर्यजमानैः प्रसूतः यष्टव्यदेवाह्वानार्थं प्रेरितः । (*purubhiryajamānaiḥ prasūtaḥ*

yaṣṭavyadevāhvānārthaṃ preritaḥ |) । Agni is praised as one who is placed by the sacrificers in many places for the performance of the Agnihotra; or as one who is sent forth by many sacrificers in the sacrifices in order to bring the gods. And in accordance with the statement of the Taittirīya Saṃhitā अग्निर्देवानां दूत आसीत् (*agnirdevānāṃ dūta āsīt*) (Tai. Saṃ.) he is also spoken of as देवानां दूतः (*devānāṃ dūtaḥ*), the messenger who brings the gods.

नः अनगान् सर्वताता वोचतु (*naḥ anagān sarvatātā vocatu*)—कर्मकर्तृसाधनवैगुण्येन सापराधानस्मान् अनागसः सर्वत्र ब्रवीतु । (*karmakartṛsādhanavaiguṇyena sāparādhānasmān anāgasaḥ sarvatra bravītu* |) । When we, the sacrificers, perform the sacrifices, we become guilty of offence through deficiency in the rite, in the doers and in the materials needed for the work; Agni is therefore prayed to release us from our deficiency.

पृथिवी, दौः, आपः, सूर्यः, अंतरिक्षं च नः शृणोतु (*pṛthivī, dauḥ, āpaḥ, sūryaḥ, aṃtarikṣaṃ ca naḥ śṛṇotu*)—The earth, the heaven, the deity of the waters, the sun and the firmament filled with stars: may these also hear the praises recited by the sacrificers. Thus the wish is expressed.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शृ॒ण्वन्तु॑ नो॒ वृष॑ण॒ः पर्व॑तासो ध्रु॒वक्षे॑मास॒ इळ॑या॒ म
द॑न्तः ।
आ॒दि॒त्यैर्नो॒ अदि॑तिः शृणोतु॒ यच्छ॑न्तु नो म॒रुत॒ः
शर्म॑ भ॒द्रम् ॥ २० ॥

> *śṛṇvantu no vṛṣaṇaḥ parvatāso dhruvakṣemāsa iḷayā madantaḥ |*
> *ādityairno aditiḥ śṛṇotu yacchantu no marutaḥ śarma bhadram ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> श‍ृण्वंतु । नः । वृषणः । पर्वतासः । ध्रुवक्षेमासः । इळेया । मदंतः ।
> आदित्यैः । नः । अदितिः । श‍ृणोतु । यच्छंतु । नः । मरुतः । शर्म । भद्रं ॥ २० ॥

> *śṛṇvaṃtu | naḥ | vṛṣaṇaḥ | parvatāsaḥ | dhruvakṣemāsaḥ | iḻèyā | madaṃtaḥ |*
> *ādityaiḥ | naḥ | aditiḥ | śṛṇotu | yacchaṃtu | naḥ | marutaḥ | śarma | bhadraṃ ‖ 20 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषणोऽभिमतफलसेचका मरुतः पर्वतासः । पृणंति पूरयंत्यर्थिनां
> कामानिति पर्वता गाव्राभिमानिनो देवाः ध्रुवक्षेमासो निश्चलस्थाना इळया
> हविर्लक्षणेनान्नेन मदंतो माद्यंतः संतो नोऽस्मदीयां स्तुतिं श‍ृण्वंतु ।
> किंच आदित्यैरपत्यभूतैरादित्यैरुपेतादितिर्नोऽस्मदीयां स्तुतिं श‍ृणोतु । मरुतश्च
> नोऽस्मभ्यं भद्रं कल्याणकरं शर्म सुखं यच्छंतु । ददतु ॥ आदित्यैः । अदितेरपत्यानीत्यर्थे
> दित्यदितीति ण्यः । प्रत्ययस्वरेणांतोदात्तः । सुपा सहैकादेशे कृत
> एकादेश उदात्तः ॥

> *vṛṣaṇo 'bhimataphalasecakā marutaḥ parvatāsaḥ | pṛṇaṃti pūrayaṃtyarthināṃ*
> *kāmāniti parvatā gāvrābhimānino devāḥ dhruvakṣemāso niścalasthānā iḻayā*
> *havirlakṣaṇenānnena madaṃto mādyaṃtaḥ saṃto no 'smadīyāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇvaṃtu |*
> *kiṃca ādityairapatyabhūtairādityairupetāditirno 'smadīyāṃ stutiṃ śṛṇotu | marutaśca*
> *no 'smabhyaṃ bhadraṃ kalyāṇakaraṃ śarma sukhaṃ yacchaṃtu | dadatu ‖ ādityaiḥ | aditerapatyānītyarthe dityaditīti ṇyaḥ |*
> *pratyayasvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | supā sahaikādeśe kṛta*
> *ekādeśa udāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

The Maruts are the "showerers", who sprinkle the fruit that is desired; they are the पर्वतासः (*parvatāsaḥ*): "they fill (पृणंति (*pṛṇaṃti*)) the wishes of those who seek", hence पर्वताः (*parvatāḥ*), the deities presiding over the pressing-stones. ध्रुवक्षेमासः (*dhruvakṣemāsaḥ*) means those whose abode is unmoving. Gladdened by the food (इळया (*iḻayā*)) in the form of the oblation, may they hear our praise. Further, may Aditi, accompanied by the Ādityas who are her offspring, hear our praise; and may the Maruts grant us auspicious, beneficent comfort (शर्म (*śarma*)), that is, happiness. यच्छंतु (*yacchaṃtu*) means "let them give".

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषणः (*vṛṣaṇaḥ*)—the Maruts, bestowers of what is desired
- पर्वतासः (*parvatāsaḥ*)—the deities presiding over the mountains, too
- ध्रुवक्षेमासः (*dhruvakṣemāsaḥ*)—having an unmoving abode
- इळया (*iḷayā*)—with the food in the form of the oblation
- मदंत (*madaṃta*)—rejoicing
- नः (*naḥ*)—our praise
- शृण्वंतु (*śṛṇvaṃtu*)—let them hear
- आदित्यैः (*ādityaiḥ*)—together with the Ādityas, her sons
- अदितिः (*aditiḥ*)—Aditi
- नः (*naḥ*)—our praise
- शृणोतु (*śṛṇotu*)—let her hear
- मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—the Maruts
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- भद्रं (*bhadraṃ*)—auspicious
- शर्म (*śarma*)—happiness
- यच्चंतु (*yaccaṃtu*)—let them give

Gist

May the Maruts, bestowers of what is desired, and the deities presiding over the mountains also, having an unmoving abode and rejoicing in the food that takes the form of the oblation, hear our praise. May Aditi, together with the Ādityas who are her sons, hear our praise. May the Maruts give us auspicious happiness.

English translation

May the (divine) showerers (of benefits), the deities of the mountains, and those abiding in flxed habitations, propitiated by the sacrificial food, hear us : may Aditi, with the Adityas, hear us : may the Maruts grant us auspicious felicity.

Special Topics

पर्वतासः (*parvatāsaḥ*)—पृणंति पूरयति अर्थिनां कार्मा इति पर्वताः ग्रावाभिमानिनो देवाः । (*pṛṇaṃti pūrayati arthināṃ kārmā iti parvatāḥ grāvābhimānino devāḥ* |) । Because they fulfil the wishes of those who take refuge in them, the deities presiding over the stones are designated by the word पर्वत (*parvata*). The prayer is described thus: these deities, the Marut deities who grant the sacrificers' desires, and the goddess Aditi together with her sons the Ādityas, satisfied by the offering of the sacrificers' oblations, shall hear the praises recited by the sacrificers.

Ṛk 21

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सदा॑ सु॒गः पि॑तु॒माँ अ॑स्तु॒ पन्था॒ मध्वा॑ देवा॒ ओष॑
धी॒◌ः सं पि॑पृक्त ।
भगो॑ मे अग्ने स॒ख्ये न मृं॑ध्या॒ उद्रा॒यो अ॑श्या॒ं सद॑
नं पुरु॒क्षोः ॥ २१ ॥

> *sadā sugaḥ pitumā~ astu panthā madhvā devā oṣadhīḥ saṃ pipṛkta |*
> *bhago me agne sakhye na mṛdhyā udrāyo aśyāṃ sadanaṃ purukṣoḥ* ‖ *21* ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> सदा । सुगः । पित्रुमान् । अस्तु । पंथाः । मध्वा । देवाः । ओषधीः । सं । पिपृक्त
> भगः । मे । अग्ने । सख्ये । न । मृध्याः । उत् । रायः । अश्यां । सदनं । पुरुषोः॥

> *sadā | sugaḥ | pitrumān | astu | paṃthāḥ | madhvā | devāḥ | oṣadhīḥ | saṃ | pipṛkta*
> *bhagaḥ | me | agne | sakhye | na | mṛdhyāḥ | ut | rāyaḥ | aśyāṃ | sadanaṃ | puruṣoḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रवत्स्यन्यजमानः सदा सुग इत्यृचं जपन् गच्छेत् । सूत्रितं च । सदा सुगः
> पितुमा अस्तु पंथा इति पंथानमवरुह्य । आ. २–५ । इति ॥
> हे अग्ने अस्माकं पंथा मार्गः सदा सर्वदा सुगः सुखेन गंतुं शक्यः पितुमानन्नवांश्चास्तु । हे देवा मध्वा माधुर्येर्पेतेनोंदकेनौषधीः सं पिपृक्त ।
> संपर्चयत । सेचयतेत्सर्थः । हे अग्ने त्वया सख्यॆ संजाते सति मे मम भगो
> धनं न मृध्याः । न विनश्यतु । किंच रायो धनस्य पुरुक्षोर्बह्वन्नस्य च सदनं स्थानमुदश्यां ।
> प्राप्नुयां ॥ सदा । स्वरादिष्वाद्युदात्तत्वेन पाठादाद्युदात्तः । पिपृक्त ।
> पृची संपर्के । लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः । बहुलं छंदसीत्यभ्यासस्यॆत्वं ।
> मृध्याः । मृधिर्हिंसार्थः । लिजि तिजां तिजो भवंतीति तिपः सिप् ॥

> *pravatsyanyajamānaḥ sadā suga ityṛcaṃ japan gacchet | sūtritaṃ ca | sadā sugaḥ*
> *pitumā astu paṃthā iti paṃthānamavaruhya | ā. 2-5 | iti ‖*
> *he agne asmākaṃ paṃthā mārgaḥ sadā sarvadā sugaḥ sukhena gaṃtuṃ śakyaḥ pitumānannavāṃścāstu | he devā madhvā mādhuryerpetenoṃdakenauṣadhīḥ saṃ pipṛkta |*
> *saṃparcayata | secayatetsarthaḥ | he agne tvayā sakhyè saṃjāte sati me mama bhago*
> *dhanaṃ na mṛdhyāḥ | na vinaśyatu | kiṃca rāyo dhanasya purukṣorbahvannasya ca sadanaṃ sthānamudaśyāṃ | prāpnuyāṃ ‖*
> *sadā | svarādiṣvādyudāttatvena pāṭhādādyudāttaḥ | pipṛkta |*
> *pṛcī saṃparke | loṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyabhyāsasyètvaṃ |*
> *mṛdhyāḥ | mṛdhirhiṃsārthaḥ | liji tijāṃ tijo bhavaṃtīti tipaḥ sip ‖*

Summary

A sacrificer about to set out should go reciting the ṛc सदा सुगः (*sadā sugaḥ*). It is also given in the sūtra: सदा सुगः पितुमा अस्तु पंथा इति पंथानमवरुह्य (*sadā sugaḥ pitumā astu paṃthā iti paṃthānamavaruhya*) (Ā. Sū. 2-5). "O Agni, may our path be always easy to travel and rich in food. O gods, with water endowed with sweetness, saturate (सं पिपृक्त (*saṃ* *piprkta*), "bring together", that is, "make them wet") the plants. O Agni, now that friendship with you has arisen, may my fortune (भगः (*bhagaḥ*), wealth) not be destroyed. And may I attain (Sanskrit udaśyām) the abode of wealth (रायः (*rāyaḥ*)) and of much food (पुरुक्षोः (*purukṣoḥ*))."

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Agni) पंथाः (*paṃthāḥ*)—our path
- सदा (*sadā*)—always
- सुगः (*sugaḥ*)—fit to be travelled with ease
- पितुमान् (*pitumān*)—furnished with food
- अस्तु (*astu*)—let it be
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—O gods
- मध्वा (*madhvā*)—with water endowed with sweetness
- ओषधीः (*oṣadhīḥ*)—the plants
- सं पिपृक्त (*saṃ piprkta*)—serve (make the plants thrive with the sweet juice)[?107]
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- सख्ये (*sakhyè*)—when your friendship exists
- मे (*me*)—my
- भगः (*bhagaḥ*)—wealth
- न मृध्याः (*na mṛdhyāḥ*)—let it not be destroyed
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—of wealth (and)
- पुरुक्षोः (*purukṣoḥ*)—of abundant food
- सदनं (*sadanaṃ*)—the abode
- उत् आश्ल्यां (*ut āślyāṃ*)—may I obtain[?108]

Gist

O Agni, may our path always be fit to be travelled with ease and furnished with food. O gods, fill the plants with sweet juice. O Agni, while your friendship is with me, may my wealth not be destroyed; and may the abode of abundant wealth and food be obtained by me.

English translation

May our path ever be easy of going, and provided with food : sprinkle, gods, the plants with sweet water : (safe) in your friendship, Agni, may my fortune never be impaired, but may I occupy a dwelling (abounding) with riches and ample food.

Special Topics

That the sacrificer who performs a sacrifice should go reciting this ṛc सदा सुगः (*sadā sugaḥ*) when he travels, is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra सदा सुगः पितुमा अस्तु पंथा इति पंथानमवरुह्य (*sadā sugaḥ pitumā astu paṃthā iti paṃthānamavaruhya*) (Ā. 2-5).

पितुर्मा (*piturmā*)—अन्नर्मा (*annarmā*)[?109]. The word पितु (*pitu*) is stated among the names of food (Ni. 3-9). The sacrificers pray to Agni that their path be pleasant and provided with food. The wish of the sacrificers is described thus: may the gods make the herbs grow with sweet waters, and may Agni bring about for the sacrificers increase, so that there is no deficiency of wealth and of abundant food.

Ṛk 22

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्वद॑स्व ह॒व्या समि॑षो दिदीह्यस्म॒द्र्य१॒॑क्सं मि॑मीहि॒ श्रवां॑सि ।
विश्वाँ॑ अग्ने पृ॒त्सु ताञ्जे॑षि॒ शत्रू॒नहा॒ विश्वा॑ सु॒मना॑ दीदिही नः ॥ २२ ॥

> *svadasva havyā samiṣo didīhyasmadryaksaṃ mimīhi śravāṃsi |*
> *viśvā~ agne pṛtsu tāñjeṣi śatrūnahā viśvā sumanā dīdihī naḥ ‖ 22 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्वदस्व । हव्या । सं । इषः । दिदीहि । अस्मद्र्यक् । सं। मिमीहि । श्रवांसि ।
> विश्वान् । अग्ने । पृत्सु । तान् । जेषि । शत्रून् । अहा । विश्वा । सुमनाः । दीदिहि।
> नः ॥ २२ ॥

> *svadasva | havyā | saṃ | iṣaḥ | didīhi | asmadryak | saṃ| mimīhi | śravāṃsi |*
> *viśvān | agne | pṛtsu | tān | jeṣi | śatrūn | ahā | viśvā | sumanāḥ | dīdihi|*
> *naḥ ‖ 22 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पशौ पुरोडाशस्विस्थकृतः स्वदस्व हव्येति याज्या । सूत्रितं च । स्वदस्व हव्या
> समिषो दिदीहीति पुरोडाशस्विस्थकृतः । आ. ३–५ । इति ॥
> हे अग्ने हव्या हवनयोग्यानि हवींषि स्वदस्व । स्वादय । अस्माकमिषोऽन्नानि
> सं दिदीहि । सम्यक् प्रकाशय । दीपितानि तानि श्रवांस्यन्नान्यस्मद्रगस्मदभिमुखानि सं
> मिमीहि ' समानय । कुर्वित्यर्थः । ततः पृत्सु संग्रामेषु तान्बाधकान्विश्वान्य
> शत्रून् जेषि । जय । अथ सुमनाः शोभनमनस्कः सन् नोऽस्माकं विश्वाहा सर्वा
> ण्यहानि दीदिहि । अग्निहोत्रादिकर्मयोग्यानि प्रकाशय ॥ स्वदस्व । स्वद आस्वादने ।
> लोटि रूपं । थासो लसार्वधातुकस्वरे धातुस्वरः । दिदीहि । दिवु क्रीडादावित्यस्य
> लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य श्लुः । परत्वात् हलि चेति दीर्घत्वे कृते पश्चाद्वलि
> लोपः । निघातः । अस्मद्रक् । अस्मानंचतीत्यंचतेः क्विप् । विश्वद्देवयोश्च टेरिति
> यणः स्वरितत्वं । मिमीहि । माज् माने शब्दे च। जुहोत्यादिः । तस्य लोटि व्यत्ययेन
> परस्मैपदं । निघातः । सुमनाः ! सोर्मनसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं ।
> दीदिहि । दिवेर्यज्लुकि लोटि तुजादित्पादभ्यासस्य दीर्घः । वलि लोपः ॥

> *paśau puroḍāśasvisthakṛtaḥ svadasva havyeti yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | svadasva havyā*
> *samiṣo didīhīti puroḍāśasvisthakṛtaḥ | ā. 3-5 | iti ‖*
> *he agne havyā havanayogyāni havīṃṣi svadasva | svādaya | asmākamiṣo 'nnāni*
> *saṃ didīhi | samyak prakāśaya | dīpitāni tāni śravāṃsyannānyasmadragasmadabhimukhāni saṃ*
> *mimīhi ' samānaya | kurvityarthaḥ | tataḥ pṛtsu saṃgrāmeṣu tānbādhakānviśvānya*
> *śatrūn jeṣi | jaya | atha sumanāḥ śobhanamanaskaḥ san no 'smākaṃ viśvāhā sarvā*
> *ṇyahāni dīdihi | agnihotrādikarmayogyāni prakāśaya ‖ svadasva | svada āsvādane |*
> *loṭi rūpaṃ | thāso lasārvadhātukasvare dhātusvaraḥ | didīhi | divu krīḍādāvityasya*
> *loṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya śluḥ | paratvāt hali ceti dīrghatve*

> *kṛte paścādvali*
> *lopaḥ | nighātaḥ | asmadrak | asmānaṃcatītyaṃcateḥ kvip |*
> *viśvadgevayośca ṭeriti*
> *yaṇaḥ svaritatvaṃ | mimīhi | māj māne śabde ca| juhotyādiḥ | tasya loṭi*
> *vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ | nighātaḥ | sumanāḥ !*
> *sormanasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ |*
> *dīdihi | diveryajluki loṭi tujāditpādabhyāsasya dīrghaḥ | vali lopaḥ ||*

Summary

In the animal sacrifice, for the puroḍāśa-sviṣṭakṛt, स्वदस्व हव्या (*svadasva havyā*) is the yājyā. It is also given in the sūtra: स्वदस्व हव्या समिषो दिदीहीति पुरोडाशस्विस्थकृतः (*svadasva havyā samiṣo didīhīti puroḍāśasvisthakṛtaḥ*) (Ā. 3-5). "O Agni, make the oblations fit for offering pleasing to the taste (स्वदस्व (*svadasva*), "make them taste sweet"). Cause our foods (इषः (*iṣaḥ*)) to shine forth well. When they have been made to shine, bring those foods (श्रवांसि (*śravāṃsi*)) together, facing us; make them so. Then conquer in the battles all those hostile enemies. And, being well-disposed, make shine for us all days, that is, make them fit for rites such as the Agnihotra."

Word-to-word meaning

अग्ने (*agne*)	O Agni
हव्या (*havyā*)	the oblations fit for the sacrifice
खादस्व (*khādasva*)	eat?110
इषः (*iṣaḥ*)	food
सं दिदीहि (*saṃ didīhi*)	furnish (to us) completely
श्रवांसि (*śravāṃsi*)	foods
अस्मद्रक् (*asmadrak*)	so as to face us
सं मिमीहि (*saṃ mimīhi*)	bring and set down
पृत्सु (*pṛtsu*)	in battles
विश्वान् (*viśvān*)	all
शत्रुन् (*śatrun*)	enemies (those)
जेषि (*jeṣi*)	conquer
सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*)	having a favourable mind
नः (*naḥ*)	for us
विश्वा अहा (*viśvā ahā*)	all days

- दीदिहि (*dīdihi*)—make shine so as to be fit for the Agnihotra

Gist

O Agni, eat the oblations fit for the sacrifice. Furnish us complete food. Bring and set the foods facing us. In battles conquer all the enemies. With a favourable mind, make all days shine for us so as to be fit for the Agnihotra.

English translation

Taste (Agni) the oblations; make manifest (for us) abundant food : measure out the viands before us : you overcome all those (who are) our enemies in conflict : favorably inclined towards us lighten up all our (cere- monies) day by day.

Special Topics

That in the animal sacrifice, when the puroḍāśa-sviṣṭakṛt offering is made, this ṛc सदस्य हव्या (*sadasya havyā*)[?111] is to be recited as the yājyā mantra, is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra सदस्व हव्या समिषो दिदीहीति पुरोडाशस्विस्थकृतः (*sadasva havyā samiṣo didīhīti puroḍāśasvisthakṛtaḥ*) (Ā. 3-5). The wishes prayed for are these: may Agni taste the oblations offered by the sacrificers; grant food to the sacrificers; provide bright foods easily; conquer the sacrificers' enemies; be gracious towards the sacrificers; and grant that rites such as the Agnihotra be accomplished without obstacle.

Sūkta 55 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> उषसः पूर्वा इति द्वाविंशत्यृचं द्वितीयं सूक्तं त्रैष्टुभं । उषस इत्यनुक्रमणिका । प्रजापतेरार्षं
> वैश्वदेवं प्रजापतिर्हि वैश्वदेवं हेति पूर्वसूक्ते
> हशब्दप्रयोगात् । सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः । अत्राद्योषस्या ततः परं नवर्चोऽ–

> *uṣasaḥ pūrvā iti dvāviṃśatyṛcaṃ dvitīyaṃ sūktaṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ | uṣasa ityanukramaṇikā | prajāpaterārṣaṃ vaiśvadevaṃ prajāpatirhi vaiśvadevaṃ heti pūrvasūkte*
> *haśabdaprayogāt | sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ | atrādyoṣasyā tataḥ paraṃ navarcoS-*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn beginning उषसः पूर्वा (*uṣasaḥ pūrvā*), of twenty-two ṛcs, is the second sūkta (of this group), in the Triṣṭubh metre. Its deity is Uṣas, according to the Anukramaṇikā. Its seer is Prajāpati, and it is addressed to the Viśvedevas, since the word ह (*ha*) is used in the preceding sūkta (प्रजापतिर्हि वैश्वदेवं हेति (*prajāpatirhi vaiśvadevaṃ heti*)). The sūkta's ritual use is indicated by the text itself (लैंगिकः (*laiṃgikaḥ*)). Here the first …[?112]

> ग्न्यादिदेवतास्ततः पराहोरात्रदेवताका ततश्चतस्रो रोदस्योः पंचदशी द्युनिशोर्वा षोडशी
> दिद्देवताका ततः षड्टचो वर्षत इंद्रस्य केचिदग्नेष्टुश्चेति
> मन्यंते ॥

> *gnyādidevatāstataḥ parāhorātradevatākā tataścatasro rodasyoḥ paṃcadaśī dyuniśorvā ṣoḍaśī diddevatākā tataḥ ṣaḍṛco varṣata iṃdrasya kecidagneṣṭuśceti*
> *manyaṃte ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

(This block continues Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta.) After the verses to Agni and the other deities comes a verse addressed to Day-and-Night (ahorātra-devatākā). Then four verses are to Rodasī, and the fifteenth is to Rodasī or to Dyunīśa (the heaven and the night).

The sixteenth has the quarters (dik) as its deity. Then six verses are addressed to the rain-giving Indra; some hold that they belong to Agni and Tvaṣṭṛ.[?113]

Anuvāda: This sūkta, Uṣasaḥ pūrvāḥ, is the second sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has twenty-two Ṛks. In the Anukramaṇikā it is introduced with the word उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*).

For this sūkta, as stated for the preceding sūkta, Prajāpati is the deity, and the Viśvedevas are the deity. The metre is Triṣṭubh. The use of the sūkta in ritual is by indication (laiṅgika). In this sūkta the first Ṛk has Uṣas as its deity; the nine Ṛks after it (Ṛks 2–10) are to Agni and the others; the next Ṛk (Ṛk 11) is to Day-and-Night; the next three Ṛks (12–14) are to Rodasī; the fifteenth Ṛk is to Rodasī or to Dyunīśau; the sixteenth Ṛk is to the quarters; the six Ṛks after that are said to be to Indra, Parjanyātmā, Tvaṣṭṛ or Agni.

Sūkta 55. Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 5; Sūkta 55. Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 3; Vargas 28, 29, 30, 31. Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 22.

Ṛṣi: Prajāpati Vaiśvāmitra, or Vāc.

Deity: the Viśvedevas. 1. Uṣas. 2–10. Agni. 11. Day-and-Night. 12–14. Rodasī. 15. Rodasī or Dyunīśau. 16. The quarters. 17–22. Indra, Parjanyātmā, Tvaṣṭṛ and Agni.

Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒षस॒ः पूर्वा॒ अध॒ यद्व्यू॒षुर्म॒हद्वि ज॑ज्ञे अ॒क्षरं॑ प॒दे गोः ।
व्र॒ता दे॒वाना॒मुप॒ नु प्र॒भूष॑न्म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसुर॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ १ ॥

> *uṣasaḥ pūrvā adha yadvyūṣurmahadvi jajñe akṣaraṃ pade goḥ |*
> *vratā devānāmupa nu prabhūṣanmahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उषसः । पूर्वाः । अध । यत् । विऊषुः । महत् । वि । जज्ञे । अक्षरं । पदे ।
> गोः ।
> व्रता । देवानां । उप । नु । प्रभूषन् । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥

> *uṣasaḥ | pūrvāḥ | adha | yat | viūṣuḥ | mahat | vi | jajñe | akṣaraṃ | pade |*
> *goḥ |*
> *vratā | devānāṃ | upa | nu | prabhūṣan | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पूर्वा उदयकालात्पाचीना उषसो यद्यदा व्यूषुर्व्यच्छंति अध तदानीमक्षरं । न क्षरतीत्यक्षरं । अविनाश्यादित्याख्यं महत्प्रभूतं ज्योतिर्गौरुदकस्य
> पदे स्थाने समुद्रे नभसि वा वि जज्ञे । उत्पद्यते । अथोदिते सूर्ये प्रभूषन्नग्निहोत्रादिकर्मसु प्रभवितुमिच्छन्यजमानो व्रता कर्माणि देवानां नु क्षिप्रमुप
> समीपं तिष्ठति । योग्यक्रियाध्याहारः । तदिदं देवानामेकं मुख्यमसुरत्वं ।
> आस्यति क्षिपति सर्वानित्यसुरः प्रबलः । तस्य भावोऽसुरत्वं प्राबल्यं । महदैश्वर्यं ॥
> व्यूषुः । उष प्लुष दाह इत्यस्य विपूर्वस्य लिट्युसि रूपं । सहेति योगविभागात्समासः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः। प्रभूषन्। भवतेः सनि द्विर्वचनस्य छंदसि विकल्पितत्पादत्र द्विर्वचनाभावः । तदंताच्चतरि रूपं । प्रादिसमासः । शतुर्लसार्वधातुकस्वरे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *pūrvā udayakālātpācīnā uṣaso yadyadā vyūṣurvyacchaṃti adha tadānīmakṣaraṃ | na kṣaratītyakṣaraṃ | avināśyādityākhyaṃ mahatprabhūtaṃ jyotirgòrudakasya*
> *pade sthāne samudre nabhasi vā vi jajñe | utpadyate | athodite sūrye prabhūṣannagnihotrādikarmasu prabhavitumicchanyajamāno vratā karmāṇi devānāṃ nu kṣipramupa*
> *samīpaṃ tiṣṭhati | yogyakriyādhyāhāraḥ | tadidaṃ devānāmekaṃ mukhyamasuratvaṃ |*
> *āsyati kṣipati sarvānityasuraḥ prabalaḥ | tasya bhāvo 'suratvaṃ prābalyaṃ | mahadaiśvaryaṃ ‖*
> *vyūṣuḥ | uṣa pluṣa dāha ityasya vipūrvasya liṭyusi rūpaṃ | saheti*

> *yogavibhāgātsamāsaḥ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ| prabhūṣan| bhavateḥ sani dvirvacanasya chaṃdasi vikalpitatpādatra dvirvacanābhāvaḥ | tadaṃtāccatari rūpaṃ | prādisamāsaḥ | śaturlasārvadhātukasvare dhātusvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"Pūrvāḥ" means the dawns that come before the time of sunrise. When they shine forth, then the imperishable (that which does not decay) great, abundant light called Āditya (the sun) is born in the "pada" of "go", that is, in the place of water: in the sea or in the sky. Then, once the sun has risen, the sacrificer who wishes to prosper in rites such as the Agnihotra offers the rites (व्रता (*vratā*) = rites) to the gods quickly; "upa" (near) is to be completed with a suitable verb, "stands near". This is the one chief "asuratva" of the gods. One who throws down (आस्यति (*āsyati*)) all is Asura, the mighty; his state is asuratva, might; "mahat" is lordship.

Word-to-word meaning

- पूर्वा (*pūrvā*)—preceding, earlier than the time of sunrise
- उपसः (*upasaḥ*)—the dawns
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- व्यूषुः (*vyūṣuḥ*)—they shine forth
- अध (*adha*)—immediately thereafter
- अक्षरं (*akṣaraṃ*)—the imperishable
- महत् (*mahat*)—and abundant light
- गोः (*goḥ*)—of water
- पदे (*pade*)—in the sky, the place of water
- वि जज्ञे (*vi jajñè*)—becomes visible
- प्रभूषन् (*prabhūṣan*)—(after sunrise) the sacrificer desiring to perform the sacrifice
- व्रता (*vratā*)—his own sacrificial and other rites
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—to the gods
- नु (*nu*)—quickly
- उप (*upa*)—offers
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might

- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

When the dawns, which come before the time of sunrise, shine forth, immediately the imperishable great light becomes visible in the sky, the place of water. After sunrise the sacrificer who desires to perform the sacrifice offers his sacrificial and other rites to the gods. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

When the preceding dawns appear, the great imperishable (light) is engendered in the (firmament, the) sphere of the waters, and then the worshipper is alert to perform the rites (due to) the gods, for great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

अक्षरं (*akṣaraṃ*)—न क्षरतीत्यक्षरं । (*na kṣaratītyakṣaraṃ* |) अविनाश्यादित्याख्यं । (*avināśyādityākhyaṃ* |) महत् प्रभूतं ज्योतिः । (*mahat prabhūtaṃ jyotiḥ* |) The word akṣara is said among the names of speech (Ni. 2-23) and among the names of water (Ni. 2-24). Sāyaṇa has explained the meaning of this word as the radiance that never meets destruction, famed by the name Āditya, and shining abundantly.

गोः पदे विजज्ञे (*goḥ pade vijajñe*)—उदकस्य स्थाने समुद्रे नभसि वा उत्पद्यते । (*udakasya sthāne samudre nabhasi vā utpadyate* |) The Nirukta-writers have explained the meaning of the word go in various ways. Sāyaṇa describes that after the time of dawn passes, the sun rises in the sea, where waters are abundant, or in the sky, and that the word go is used in the sense of sea or sky.

व्रता (*vratā*)—कर्माणि । (*karmāṇi* |) The word vrata is explained by Yāska (Ni. 2-13): वृणोतीति व्रतं (*vṛṇotīti vrataṃ*), वारयतीति व्रतं (*vārayatīti vrataṃ*), अवृणोतीति शरीरं इति व्रतं । (*avṛṇotīti śarīraṃ iti vrataṃ* |) First: शुभमशुभं वा कृतं सदा वृणोति कर्तारं (*śubhamaśubhaṃ vā kṛtaṃ sadā vṛṇoti kartāraṃ*)—the fruit, good or bad, follows the one who did the work. Therefore the word vrata means action. Second: because it keeps those who practise rites such as the Agnihotra from enjoying objects of enjoyment, the meaning vrata is described. Third: because it is transformed into the seven bodily constituents, food too is called by the word vrata.

प्रभूषन् व्रता देवानां उपः नु नेष्यति (*prabhūṣan vratā devānāṃ upaḥ nu neṣyati*) —अग्निहोत्रादि कर्मसु प्रभवितुमिच्छ यजमानः कर्माणि देवानां उप समीपं नेष्यति— (*agnihotrādi karmasu prabhavitumiccha yajamānaḥ karmāṇi devānāṃ upa samīpaṃ neṣyati*—) it is explained that after the sun has half risen, the sacrificer who wishes to prosper offers the rites he performs, to win the satisfaction of the gods.

देवानां असुरत्वं एकं महत् (*devānāṃ asuratvaṃ ekaṃ mahat*)—in this sentence Sāyaṇa explains the word asura thus: अस्यति क्षिपति सर्वानित्यसुरः प्रबलः (*asyati kṣipati sarvānityasuraḥ prabalaḥ*), तस्य भावः असुरत्वं प्राबल्यं । (*tasya bhāvaḥ asuratvaṃ prābalyaṃ* |) He who has abundant power to subdue all is Asura, and the power of one so endowed is asuratva. It is described that, in accord with the performance of sacrifices and so on, with the manifestation of the sun's rising, and because of the course of the dawn-times, the lordship of the gods is complete, in its abundant greatness, and chiefly praiseworthy.

The word asura is said among the names of cloud (Ni. 2-22). And: असुराः असुरताः स्थानेष्टस्ताः स्थानेभ्य इति वा अपि ना असुरिति प्राणनाम अस्तः शरीरे भवति तेन तद्वंतः (*asurāḥ asuratāḥ sthāneṣṭastāḥ sthānebhya iti vā api nā asuriti prāṇanāma astaḥ śarīre bhavati tena tadvaṃtaḥ*) (Ni. 3-8): that is, those who are settled in a region or place, or those who have fallen from their places, or those who have restless breath; thus Yāska has explained the meaning of asura. And Yāska cites the Brāhmaṇa passage सोर्देवानसृजत तत् सुराणां सुरत्वं असोरसुरानसृजत तदसुराणामसुरत्वमिति विज्ञायते (*sordèvānasṛjata tat surāṇāṃ suratvaṃ asorasurānasṛjata tadasurāṇāmasuratvamiti vijñāyate*): Brahmā created the gods from a praiseworthy region of the Supreme Self, and created the asuras from an unpraiseworthy region.

For the word asura here the commentator gives the meaning निरसितारं देवं (*nirasitāraṃ devaṃ*): the god who overcomes (enemies). Although the sense "demons" is current for asura, in many places the word has a meaning favourable to the gods. In this Aṣṭaka the word asura occurs in about ten Ṛks, and everywhere it has the sense of the gods.

In the Ṛk दिवो अस्तोष्यसुरस्य वीरैरिषुध्येव मरुतो रोदस्कोः । (*divo astoṣyasurasya vīrairiṣudhyeva maruto rodaskoḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-122-1): असुरस्य निरसितव्यानामसुराणां निरसितुः । (*asurasya nirasitavyānāmasurāṇāṃ nirasituḥ* |) कर्मणि षष्ठी । (*karmaṇi ṣaṣṭhī* |) निरसितारं तमेव देवं (*nirasitāraṃ tameva devaṃ*) (Rudra): the meaning is Rudra, who overcomes the asuras.

शतं राज्यो नाधमानस्य निष्काञ्चितमश्वान्प्रयतान्त्सद्य आदं । शतं कक्षीवा असुरस्य गोनां दिवि श्रवोजरमा ततान ॥ (*śataṃ rājyo nādhamānasya niṣkāñcitamaśvānprayatāntsadya ādaṃ | śataṃ kakṣīvā asurasya gonāṃ divi śravojaramā tatāna* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-126-2). Here: असुरस्य धनानां निरसितुर्दानशीलस्य राज्ञः स्वनयस्य । (*asurasya dhanānāṃ nirasiturdānaśīlasya rājñaḥ svanayasya* |) That is, "of the king Svanaya, who gives wealth and the like"; thus the word asura refers to King Svanaya.

इंद्राय हि द्यौरसुरो अनम्नतेंद्राय मही पृथिवी वरीमभिर्दुम्मसाता वरीमभिः ॥ (*iṃdrāya hi dyaurasuro anamnateṃdrāya mahī pṛthivī varīmabhirdummasātā varīmabhiḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-31-1). Here the word asura is explained असुरः निरसनशीलः शत्रूणां पुण्यकृतामेव तन्निवासात् (*asuraḥ nirasanaśīlaḥ śatrūṇāṃ puṇyakṛtāmeva tannivāsāt*) (दौः द्युलोकः (*dauḥ dyulokaḥ*)): it is an epithet of the word दौः (*dauḥ*), the heavenly world, which is a dwelling for the meritorious who perform sacrifices and so on and gives no room to their enemies.

प्र सा क्षितिरसुर या महि प्रिय ऋतावानावृतमा घोषतो बृहत् । (*pra sā kṣitirasura yā mahi priya ṛtāvānāvṛtamā ghoṣato bṛhat* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-51-4). In this Ṛk the word asura is explained हे असुरा असुर् बलवंतौ मित्रावरुणौ । (*he asurā asur balavaṃtau mitrāvaruṇau* |) As an epithet of Mitra and Varuṇa it states their strength and power.

त्वं राजेंद्र ये च देवा रक्षा नृन्पाह्यसुर त्वमस्मान् । (*tvaṃ rājeṃdra ye ca devā rakṣā nṛnpāhyasura tvamasmān* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-174-1). In this Ṛk: असुर शत्रूणां निरसितः हे इंद्र । (*asura śatrūṇāṃ nirasitaḥ he iṃdra* |) "O Indra, who overcomes enemies"; the word asura is used of Indra.

त्वमग्ने रुद्रो असुरो महो दिवस्त्वं शर्धो मारुतं पृक्ष ईशिषे । (*tvamagne rudro asuro maho divastvaṃ śardho mārutaṃ pṛkṣa īśiṣe* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-1-6). In this Ṛk the word asura gives the sense: असुरः शत्रूणां निरसिता रुद्रोऽसि । (*asuraḥ śatrūṇāṃ nirasitā rudro 'si* |) "You are Rudra, who conquers the enemy."

त्वं विश्वेषां वरुणासि राजा ये च देवा असुर ये च मर्ताः । (*tvaṃ viśveṣāṃ varuṇāsi rājā ye ca devā asura ye ca martāḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-27-10). Here the word asura means हे असुर शत्रूणां क्षेपक वरुण । (*he asura śatrūṇāṃ kṣepaka varuṇa* |) "O Varuṇa, who overthrows enemies"; the word asura refers to Varuṇa.

मा नो वधैर्वरुण ये त इष्टावेनः कृण्वंतमसुर भ्रीणंति । (*mā no vadhairvaruṇa ye ta iṣṭāvenaḥ kṛṇvaṃtamasura bhrīṇaṃti* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-28-7). In this Ṛk too: हे असुर पापकृतां निरसितः वरुण । (*he asura pāpakṛtāṃ nirasitaḥ varuṇa* |) "Varuṇa, who restrains those who do wrong"; it refers to Varuṇa.

बृहस्पते तपुषाश्नेव विध्य वृक्कद्वरसो असुरस्य वीरान् । (*bṛhaspate tapuṣāśneva vidhya vṛkkadvaraso asurasya vīrān* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-30-4). In this Ṛk the word असुरस्य (*asurasya*) is an epithet of the word वृकद्वरसः (*vṛkadvarasaḥ*): संवृतद्वारस्य असुरस्य (*saṃvṛtadvārasya asurasya*)—of the asura who has shut and barred the door; thus the ordinary meaning of asura is explained.

पिता यज्ञा नामसुरो विपश्चितां विमानमग्निर्वयुनं च वाघतां । (*pitā yajñā nāmasuro vipaścitāṃ vimānamagnirvayunaṃ ca vāghatāṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-3-4). In this Ṛk: असुरो बलप्रदः (*asuro balapradaḥ*)—the word asura is used of Agni.

Here the word एक (*eka*) is used in the sense "chief", not as a numeral. And the word महत् (*mahat*), Sāyaṇa's explanation says, means lordship, that is, having everything under one's control. By this it is suggested that the might of the gods is unequalled, or that the gods have the power, unattainable by any others, of keeping everything under their control. And this being so, the might of this lordship is also chief; thus a threefold meaning is also suggested through the relation of subject and predicate in the words एकं असुरत्वं महत् (*ekaṃ asuratvaṃ mahat*).

In this Ṛk, which describes the power of the deity Uṣas, it is described that since the performance of sacrifices and other rites by sacrificers, the sunrise and other activities come about through the unsurpassed lordship of the deity Uṣas, the greatness of the deity is chief.

In every Ṛk of this sūkta the fourth pāda of this Ṛk, महद्देवानामसुरत्वमेकं (*mahaddevānāmasuratvamekaṃ*), is recited again and again like a refrain.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मो षू णो॒ अत्र॑ जुहुरन्त दे॒वा मा पूर्वे॑ अग्ने पि॒तरः॑ प॒दज्ञाः ।
पु॒रा॒ण्योः सद्म॑नोः के॒तु॒र॒न्तर्म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ २ ॥

> *mo ṣū ṇo atra juhuranta devā mā pūrve agne pitaraḥ padajñāḥ |*
> *purāṇyoḥ sadmanoḥ keturantarmahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मो इति । सु । नः । अत्र । जुहुरंत । देवाः । मा । पूर्वे । अग्ने । पितरः ।
> पदज्ञाः ।
> पुराण्योः । सद्मनोः । केतुः । अंतः । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ २ ॥

> *mo iti | su | naḥ | atra | juhuraṃta | devāḥ | mā | pūrve | agne |*
> *pitaraḥ |*
> *padajñāḥ |*
> *purāṇyoḥ | sadmanoḥ | ketuḥ | aṃtaḥ | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ*
> *| ekaṃ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने आत्रास्मिन्काले देवा नोऽस्मान् सु सुष्टु मो जुहुरंत । मा
> हिंस्युः । तथा पदज्ञाः कर्माण्यनुष्ठाय देवपदमनुभवंतः पूर्व पुरातनाः
> पितरो मा हिंसिपुः । यस्मात्केतुर्यज्ञानां प्रज्ञापकः । सूर्यः पुराणोः
> पुरातनयोः सद्मनोः । सीदंत्यनयोर्देवमनुष्या इति सद्मनी रोदसी । तयोरंतेर्मध्य उदेति ।
> तस्मादत्र मा हिंसंतित्यर्थः । महद्देवानामित्यादि पूर्ववत् ॥
> जुहुरंत । हृ प्रसह्यकरणे । लुजि जुहोत्यादित्वात् श्लुः । व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं ।
> बहुलं छंदसीत्युत्वं । संज्ञापूर्वकस्य विधेरनित्यत्वाददादादेशाभावे०ंतादेशः ॥

> *he agne ātrāsminkāle devā no 'smān su suṣṭu mo juhuraṃta | mā himsyuḥ | tathā padajñāḥ karmāṇyanuṣṭhāya devapadamanubhavaṃtaḥ pūrva purātanāḥ*
> *pitaro mā hiṃsipuḥ | yasmātketuryajñānāṃ prajñāpakaḥ | sūryaḥ purāṇoḥ*
> *purātanayoḥ sadmanoḥ | sīdaṃtyanayordevamanuṣyā iti sadmanī rodasī | tayoraṃtèrmadhya udeti | tasmādatra mā hiṃsaṃtityarthaḥ | mahaddevānāmityādi pūrvavat ‖*
> *juhuraṃta | hṛ prasahyakaraṇe | luji juhotyāditvāt śluḥ | vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyutvaṃ | saṃjñāpūrvakasya vidheranityatvādadādādeśābhāveoṃtādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, at this time (अत्र (*atra*)) may the gods not harm us (नः (*naḥ*)); सु (*su*) (well), मो जुहुरंत (*mo juhuraṃta*): let them not harm." Likewise the ancient fathers (पितरः (*pitaraḥ*)), who know the step (पदज्ञाः (*padajñāḥ*)), having performed rites and attained the divine station, must not harm us. For the sun, the signal (केतुः (*ketuḥ*)) who makes the sacrifices known, rises between the two ancient dwellings (सद्मनोः (*sadmanoḥ*)): they are called sadmanī, heaven and earth, because gods and men dwell (sīdanti) in them. Therefore here (at that time) they do not harm; this is the meaning. महद्देवानामित्यादि (*mahaddevānāmityādi*) is as before.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni

- अत्र (*atra*)—at this time of the sacrifice
- देवा: (*devā:*)—the gods
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- सु मो जुहुरंते (*su mo juhuraṃtè*)—let them not harm in the least
- पदज्ञा: (*padajñā:*)—those who have attained godhood
- पूर्वे (*pūrve*)—and ancient
- पितरः (*pitaraḥ*)—our fathers also
- मा (*mā*)—let them not harm us
- केतुः (*ketuḥ*)—the sun, who makes the sacrificial work known
- पुराण्योः (*purāṇyoḥ*)—of the ancient
- सद्मनोः (*sadmanoḥ*)—heaven and earth
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—shining in the middle (let him not harm us)
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

O Agni, at this time of the sacrifice let the gods not harm us in the least; let our ancient fathers too, who have attained godhood, not harm us. Let the sun, who makes the sacrificial work known, shining in the middle of ancient heaven and earth, not harm us. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Let not the gods, Agni, now do us harm, nor the ancient progenitors, who have come to know the degree (of divinity) ; nor the manifester of light between the two ancient dwellings (earth and heaven, the sun) ; for great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

केतुः पुराण्योः सद्मनोः अंतः (*ketuḥ purāṇyoḥ sadmanoḥ aṃtaḥ*)—यज्ञानां प्रज्ञापकः सूर्यः पुरातनयोः (*yajñānāṃ prajñāpakaḥ sūryaḥ purātanayoḥ*) सीदंत्यनयोः देवमनुष्या इति सद्मनी (*sīdaṃtyanayoḥ devamanuṣyā iti sadmanī*) तयोः मध्ये उदेति । (*tayoḥ madhyè udeti |*) Having explained the meaning of the word ketu as the sun, who marks the required time of duty, the performance of sacrifice, the commentary says that this sun rises in the middle of heaven and earth, which have existed from ancient times and have granted gods and men the opportunity to live in comfort. At this time of rising, Agni is prayed to: देवाः पितरः नः मा जुहुरंत (*devāḥ pitaraḥ naḥ mā juhuraṃta*) अस्र्मा मा हिंस्युः (*arsmā mā hiṃsyuḥ*) —let the gods, and also the fathers who have attained the state of gods through the performance of sacrifices and other rites, not harm us, the sacrificers. The word sadmanī is said among the names of heaven and earth (Ni. 3-22).

पितरः (*pitaraḥ*)—Among the dead, the meritorious dwell in the third heaven; they are called fathers. They are the original progenitors, who followed the ancient paths (10-15-8, 10): the dead follow the very path laid out by these ṛṣis and go to their vicinity.

(10-14-2, 7, 15). He is connected with the third step of Viṣṇu (10-15-3; compare 1-154-5). Two sūktas have the Pitṛs as deity (10-15; 10-54).

Among the Pitṛs there are the groups of the Navagvas, Virūpas, Aṅgirases, Atharvans, Bhṛgus and Vasiṣṭhas (10-14-4 to 6; 10-15-8). The last four of these are names. They are also the names of the seers of the Atharvaveda and of the second and seventh maṇḍalas of the Ṛgveda. Among them the Aṅgirases have a special relation to Yama (10-14-3, 5). The Pitṛs are also divided into avarāḥ (lower rank), parāḥ (higher rank) and madhyamāḥ (middle rank). Although they are not all known to their descendants, Agni knows all of them (10-15-1, 2, 13). The favour of the Pitṛs is prayed for together with the Dawns, rivers, mountains, heaven and earth, Pūṣan and the Ṛbhus (6-52-4; 6-75-10; 7-35-12; 1-06-3). There is a prayer that they grant wealth, offspring and long life to their descendants who seek their gracious glance (10-14-6) (10-15-7, 11; A. Ve. 18-3-14; 18-4-62)[?114]. The Vasiṣṭhas are prayed to help their descendants (7-33-1; compare 10-15-8); Turuṣva, Yadu and Ugradeva are also praised individually (1-36.18).

The Pitṛs are immortal (A. Ve. 6-41-3); they are also called gods (10-56-4). In the Aṅgirases and some groups, priesthood is joined to divinity. Some acts of creation are also ascribed to certain Pitṛs: it was they who made the sky adorned with stars; light by day and darkness by night came from them (18-68-11); they found the hidden light and brought about the dawn (7-26-4; compare 10-107-1); and together with Soma they spread out heaven and earth (8.48-13). Just as there is a difference between the Agni that carries the oblation to the gods (havyavāha) and the Agni that burns the corpse (kravyād) (10-16-9), so there is a difference between the path of the gods and the path of the ancestors (10-2-7; compare 10-18-1; 10-88-15). In the same way a distinction between the world of heaven and the world of the Pitṛs is stated; the door of the world of the gods is said to lie in the north-east (Śa. Brā. 6-6-2-9) and the door of the world of the Pitṛs in the south-east (Śa. Brā. 13-8-1-5). The Pitṛs and men are different classes, and their creation is also separate (Tai. Brā. 2-3-8-2). The Pitṛs dwell on earth, in the atmosphere and in heaven (A. Ve. 18-2-49; compare Ṛ. Ve. 10-15-2).

The ancient Pitṛs once offered a Soma oblation (10-15-8). They pass their time happily with Yama (10-14-1; compare 10-135-1 and A. Ve. 18-4-10) and feast with the gods (7-76-4). Living like the gods, they sometimes receive the worship proper to the gods, and Indra and

the worship proper to the gods. They come in the chariot of Indra and the gods (10-15-10). They too have a longing for the Soma juice (10-15-5, 6); seated facing south on the darbha seat, they drink the pressed drink (10-15-5, 6). They are eager to drink the Soma juice prepared for them; they are invited to come with Yama, his father Vivasvat and Agni, and with them to accept what has been offered (10-15-8 to 11; 10-14-4, 5). They come in thousands and sit down in order on the darbha seat (10-15-10, 11). When the Pitṛs come to the sacrificial hall, certain piśācas also mingle with them in the guise of their friends (Ā. Ve. 18-2-28)[?115].

When food is offered to the gods one says "svāhā", and when it is given to the Pitṛs one says "svadhā" (10-14-3); in all rites this distinction between the share of the gods and that of the Pitṛs must be kept (Śa. Brā. 4-4-2-2). They too receive worship; the prayers are that they listen to the entreaty of their followers, take their side, and forgive the lapses that naturally occur, and so on (10-15-2, 6; compare 3-55-2).

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि मे॑ पुरु॒त्रा प॑तयन्ति॒ कामा॒ः शम्यच्छा॑ दीद्ये पू॒र्व्याणि॑ ।
समि॑द्धे अ॒ग्नावृ॒तमिद्व॑देम म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒रत्वमेक॑म् ॥
३ ॥

> *vi me purutrā patayanti kāmāḥ śamyacchā dīdye pūrvyāṇi |*
> *samiddhe agnāvṛtamidvadema mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वि । मे । पुरुत्रा । पतयंति । कामाः । शमि । अच्छ । दीद्ये । पूर्व्याणि ।
> सम्इद्धे । अग्नौ । ऋतं । इत् । वदेम । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥

> *vi | me | purutrā | patayaṃti | kāmāḥ | śami | accha | dīdye | pūrvyāṇi |*
> *samidde | agnau | ṛtaṃ | it | vadema | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने मे मम पुरुत्रा बहवः कामा अभिलाषा वि पतयंति । विविधं
> गच्छंति । शम्यग्निष्टोमादिलक्षणं कर्माच्चाभिलक्ष्याहं पूर्वाणि पुरातनानि स्तोत्राणि तदर्थं दीद्ये ।
> दीपयामि । पश्चाद्यज्ञार्थमग्नौ समिद्धे दीप्यमाने सत्यृतमित् सत्यमेव वदेम । अनृतवचने हि
> यज्ञे वैगुण्यं स्यादिति ॥ पुरुत्रा । देवमनुष्यपुरुषेत्यादिना त्राप्रत्ययः । पतयंति । पत्लृ गत् ।
> स्वार्थिको ण्च् ॥

> *he agne me mama purutrā bahavaḥ kāmā abhilāṣā vi patayaṃti |*
> *vividhaṃ*
> *gacchaṃti | śamyagniṣṭomādilakṣaṇaṃ karmāccābhilakṣyāhaṃ pūrvāṇi*
> *purātanāni stotrāṇi tadarthaṃ dīdye | dīpayāmi |*
> *paścādyajñārthamagnau samiddhe dīpyamāne satyṛtamit satyameva*

> *vadema | anṛtavacane hi yajñe vaiguṇyaṃ syāditi ‖ purutrā | devamanuṣyapuruṣetyādinā trāpratyayaḥ | patayaṃti | patlṛ gat | svārthiko ṇc ‖*

Summary

O Agni, my many desires (कामाः (*kāmāḥ*), longings) go off in various directions (वि पतयंति (*vi patayaṃti*)). Aiming at a rite such as the Agniṣṭoma (शमि (*śami*) is the rite), I kindle (दीद्ये (*dīdye*): I light up) ancient hymns for its sake. Afterwards, when the fire is kindled for the sacrifice, we shall speak only the truth, for if untruth is spoken there would be a defect in the sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- मे (*me*)—my
- पुरुत्रा (*purutrā*)—of many kinds
- कामाः (*kāmāḥ*)—desires
- वि पतयंति (*vi patayaṃti*)—spread out in various ways
- शमि (*śami*)—the rite of the form of Agniṣṭoma and the like
- अच्छ (*accha*)—aiming at
- पूर्वाणि (*pūrvāṇi*)—ancient hymns
- दीद्ये (*dīdye*)—I recite, making them shine
- अग्नौ (*agnau*)—when Agni
- समिद्धे (*samiddhe*)—is kindled (for the sacrifice)
- ऋतमित् (*ṛtamit*)—only true speech
- वदेम (*vadema*)—we utter
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

O Agni, my desires, of many kinds, spread out in various ways. For the sake of the rite of the form of Agniṣṭoma and the like, I recite ancient hymns, making them shine. When Agni is kindled for the sacrifice, we utter only true speech. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Variously do my manifold desires alight : present at the solemnity, I recite ancient (hymns) : when the fire is kindled we speak indeed the truth, for great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

शमि अच्छ पूर्वाणि दीद्ये (*śami accha pūrvāṇi dīdye*)—अग्निष्टोमादिलक्षणं कर्म अभिलक्ष्य अहं पुरातनानि स्तोत्राणि तदर्थं दीपयामि । (*agniṣṭomādilakṣaṇaṃ karma abhilakṣya ahaṃ purātanāni stotrāṇi tadarthaṃ dīpayāmi* |). The word शमि (*śami*) is listed among the names of rites (Ni. 3-2). Sāyaṇa has explained the meaning as sacrificial rites such as the Agniṣṭoma. The sacrificer, addressing Agni, recites praises so that his many desires may be fulfilled; and, as for अनृतवचने हि यज्ञे वैगुण्यं स्यादिति ऋतमित् सत्यवेव वदेम (*anṛtavacane hi yajñè vaiguṇyaṃ syāditi ṛtamit satyaveva vadema*), he explains that if falsehood is spoken while the sacrifice is going on, the sacrifice would not yield its full fruit or would be afflicted with deficiency, and therefore he speaks true words. It is described that Agni, having heard the sacrificer's praises, fulfils all his wishes, and that he possesses a chief and unequalled greatness.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒मा॒नो राजा॒ विभृ॑तः पुरु॒त्रा शये॑ श॒यासु॒ प्रयु॑तो॒ वनानु॑ ।
अ॒न्या व॒त्सं भर॑ति॒ क्षेति॑ मा॒ता म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ ४ ॥

> *samāno rājā vibhṛtaḥ purutrā śaye śayāsu prayuto vanānu |*
> *anyā vatsaṃ bharati kṣeti mātā mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> समानः । राजा । विभृतः । पुरुत्रा । शये । शयासु । प्रयुतः । वना । अनु ।
> अन्या । वत्सं । भरति । क्षेति । माता । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ४ ॥

> *samānaḥ | rājā | vibhṛtaḥ | purutrā | śaye | śayāsu | prayutaḥ | vanā | anu |*
> *anyā | vatsaṃ | bharati | kṣeti | mātā | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> समानः साधारणः सर्वेषां । यद्वा । एक एव राजा दीप्यमानोऽग्निः पुरुत्रा बहुषु देशेषु
> विभृतोऽग्नि होत्रार्थं विहृतो भवति । यद्वा । राजाभिषुतः
> सोमः सर्वेषु देशेषु यज्ञार्थं विहृतो भवति । स चाग्निः सोमो वा शयासु
> शेरते हविरादयः पदार्था अत्रेति शया वेद्यः । तासु शये । शेते । निवसति ।
> वनानु अनुवनं वनेष्वरणिरूपेषु काष्ठेषु प्रयुतो विभक्तोऽग्निर्वर्तते ।
> सोमश्चेद्वनेषु चमसेषु विभक्तो वर्तते । तस्य द्वे मातरौ द्यावापृथिव्यौ ।
> तयोरन्या द्यौरस्या भूमेर्जायमानतया वत्सं वत्सभूतमग्निं सोमं वा
> भरति । वृष्टा दिरूपेण भरति । पोषयति । माता वसुधा क्षेति । केवलं निवासयति ॥
> विभृतः । हृञ् हरणे । कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं । पुरुत्रा ।
> अधिकरणे त्राप्रत्ययः । शये । शीज् स्वप्ने । लोपस्त इति तकारलोपः । शीजः
> सार्वधातुके गुणः । शयासु । शीञ् स्वप्ने । एरजित्यधिकरणेऽच् । भरति । भृञ्
> भरणे । भूवादिः । एकान्याभ्यां समर्थाभ्यामिति पूर्वस्य न निघातः । क्षेति ।
> क्षि निवासगत्योरित्यस्य लटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् ॥

> *samānaḥ sādhāraṇaḥ sarveṣāṃ | yadvā | eka eva rājā dīpyamāno 'gniḥ purutrā bahuṣu deśeṣu vibhṛto 'gni hotrārthaṃ vihṛto bhavati | yadvā | rājābhiṣutaḥ*
> *somaḥ sarveṣu deśeṣu yajñārthaṃ vihṛto bhavati | sa cāgniḥ somo vā śayāsu*
> *śerate havirādayaḥ padārthā atreti śayā vedyaḥ | tāsu śaye | śete | nivasati |*
> *vanānu anuvanaṃ vaneṣvaraṇirūpeṣu kāṣṭheṣu prayuto vibhakto 'gnirvartate |*
> *somaścedvaneṣu camaseṣu vibhakto vartate | tasya dve mātarau dyāvāpṛthivyau |*
> *tayoranyā dyaurasyā bhūmerjāyamānatayā vatsaṃ vatsabhūtamagniṃ somaṃ vā*

> *bharati | vṛṣṭā dirūpeṇa bharati | poṣayati | mātā vasudhā kṣeti | kevalaṃ nivāsayati ‖*
> *vibhṛtaḥ | hṛñ haraṇe | karmaṇi ktaḥ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ | purutrā |*
> *adhikaraṇe trāpratyayaḥ | śaye | śīṃ svapne | lopasta iti takāralopaḥ | śīṃjaḥ*
> *sārvadhātuke guṇaḥ | śayāsu | śīñ svapne | erajityadhikaraṇe 'c | bharati | bhṛñ*
> *bharaṇe | bhūvādiḥ | ekānyābhyāṃ samarthābhyāmiti pūrvasya na nighātaḥ | kṣeti |*
> *kṣi nivāsagatyorityasya laṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk ‖*

Summary

समानः (*samānaḥ*) means common to all. Or else: the one shining king, Agni, is carried about (विभृतः (*vibhṛtaḥ*)) in many places for the Agnihotra. Or else: the king is the pressed Soma, who is carried about in all places for the sacrifice. That Agni or Soma lies (शये (*śaye*): rests, dwells) in the शयासु (*śayāsu*), that is, the altars, where the oblations and other things lie. In the वनानु (*vanānu*), that is, in the logs of wood in the form of the araṇi, Agni exists, distributed; if it is Soma, he exists distributed in the वनेषु (*vaneṣu*), the cups (चमसेषु (*camaseṣu*)). He has two mothers, heaven and earth. Of these, the one, heaven, bears (भरति (*bharati*)) the child (वत्सं (*vatsaṃ*))—Agni or Soma, who is born of the other, the earth—by rain and the like; she nourishes him. The mother, earth, क्षेति (*kṣeti*): merely gives a dwelling.

Word-to-word meaning

- समानः (*samānaḥ*)—he who is common to the whole world (the one sole lord)
- राजा (*rājā*)—Agni, the shining one
- पुरुत्रा (*purutrā*)—in many regions
- विभृतः (*vibhṛtaḥ*)—is carried (for the sacrifice)
- शयासु (*śayāsu*)—in the sacrificial altars
- शये (*śaye*)—is established
- वनानु (*vanānu*)—in the logs of the form of araṇi
- प्रयुतः (*prayutaḥ*)—is distributed

- अन्या (*anyā*)—one (of heaven and earth), the heavenly world
- वत्सं (*vatsaṃ*)—Agni, who is like a son
- भरति (*bharati*)—nourishes
- माता (*mātā*)—the earth, who is of the form of a mother
- क्षेति (*kṣeti*)—gives room to dwell
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Agni, the one sole lord of the whole world, the shining one, is carried to many regions for the sacrifice and is established in the sacrificial altars. He lies hidden, distributed, in the logs of the form of araṇi. Of heaven and earth, the heavenly world nourishes Agni, who is like a son; the earth, who is of the form of a mother, gives room to dwell. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

The universal sovereign is conveyed to many directions : he sleeps in the places of repose : he is connected with the forests : one mother (heaven) nourishes the child ; the other (earth) gives him a dwelling : great and unqualled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

समानः राजा पुरुत्रा विभृतः (*samānaḥ rājā purutrā vibhṛtaḥ*)—सर्वेषां साधारणः दीप्यमानो अग्निः बहुषु देशेषु अग्निहोत्रार्थं विहृतो भवति । (*sarveṣām sādhāraṇaḥ dīpyamāno agniḥ bahuṣu deśeṣu agnihotrārthaṃ vihṛto bhavati* |). One kind of meaning is stated: Agni, who is regarded by all without any distinction of less or more, and who shines with abundant radiance, moves about in many regions so that the Agnihotra and other rites performed by sacrificers may be accomplished.

In the second meaning the word राजा (*rājā*) is used in the sense of Soma. Soma (and likewise Agni), though one, is pressed at one time in the many different sacrifices and is thus common to all the priests. It is therefore explained that he is useful for the sacrifice in all regions.

शयासु (*śayāsu*)—शेरते हविरादयः पदार्थाः अत्र (*śerate havirādayaḥ padārthāḥ atra*): it is described as the sacrificial altars on which things in the form of oblations and other things are placed. Both Agni and this Soma are established on the altars by the priests and others.

Agni is वनानु प्रयुतः (*vanānu prayutaḥ*)—he is separate in the piece of wood that is in the form of the araṇi. In the same way Soma too वनेषु चमसेषु विभक्तः वर्तते (*vaneṣu camaseṣu vibhaktaḥ vartate*)—he is placed so as to be separate in the vessel called camasa which is used in the sacrifice.

By these two statements, समानः राजा पुरुत्रा विधृतः शयासु शेरते (*samānaḥ rājā purutrā vidhṛtaḥ śayāsu śerate*), a common property of Agni and Soma is stated, so that their similarity is understood. Yāska has read the word वन (*vana*) among the names of rays (Ni. 2-15). Sāyaṇa has explained the meanings araṇi and camasa. Heaven and earth perform the function of a mother for Agni and for Soma.

अन्या वत्सं भरति (*anyā vatsaṃ bharati*)—द्यौः अन्याः भूमेः जायमानतया वत्सभूतमग्निं सोमं वा पोषयति । (*dyauḥ anyāḥ bhūmeḥ jāyamānatayā vatsabhūtamagniṃ somaṃ vā poṣayati* |). The heavenly world nourishes Soma, who is produced on the earth, and Agni, who is produced from the araṇis, by supplying waters in the form of rain, as one nourishes a child.

माता क्षेति (*mātā kṣeti*)—वसुधा निवासयति (*vasudhā nivāsayati*). The earth provides a dwelling-place so that the two may live happily. Producing and providing a dwelling-place are both the function of a mother. Since this function is the same for both Agni and Soma, the earth is the mother of both. The heavenly world, too, is a mother because it nourishes and makes them grow; and thus the unequalled might of the gods is described.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒क्षित्पूर्वा॒स्वप॑रा अ॒नू॒रुत्स॒द्यो जा॒तासु॒ तरु॑णीष्व॒न्तः

।

अ॒न्तर्व॑तीः सुवते॒ अप्र॑वीता म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑क॑म्

॥ ५ ॥

> *ākṣitpūrvāsvaparā anūrutsadyo jātāsu taruṇīṣvantaḥ |*
> *antarvatīḥ suvate apravītā mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आक्षितित् । पूर्वासु । अपराः । अनूरुत् । सद्यः । जातासु । तरुणीषु । अंतरिति ।
> अंतःसवतीः । सुवते । अप्रवीताः । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ५ ॥

> *ākṣitit | pūrvāsu | aparāḥ | anūrut | sadyaḥ | jātāsu | taruṇīṣu |*
> *aṃtariti |*
> *aṃtaḥsavatīḥ | suvate | apravītāḥ | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ |*
> *ekaṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पूर्वासु जीर्णास्वोषधीष्वाक्षिदावर्तमानस्तथापरा नव्या ओषधीरनूरुदनुरुंधन् उत्पत्त्यानुगुण्येनानुतिष्ठन्नग्निः सूर्यो वा सद्यो जातासु तदानीमुत्पन्नासु तरुणेषु पल्लवितास्वोषधीष्वंतर्वर्तते । ता ओषधयोऽप्रवीताः

> *pūrvāsu jīrṇāsvoṣadhīṣvākṣidāvartamānastathāparā navyā oṣadhīranūrudanuruṃdhan utpattyānuguṇyenānutiṣṭhannagniḥ sūryo vā sadyo jātāsu tadānīmutpannāsu taruṇeṣu pallavitāsvoṣadhīṣvaṃtarvartate | tā oṣadhayo 'pravītāḥ*

> केनापि पुरुषेणानिषिक्तरेतस्का अनभ्यक्ता वा अंतवर्ततीरग्निना गर्भवत्यो भूत्वा सुवते । फलं पुष्पं चोत्पादयंति । तदिदं देवानामैश्वर्यं ॥ आक्षित् । क्षि निवासगत्योः । क्विप् । अनूरुत् । अनौ रुध कामे । अस्मात् क्विप् । अन्वेषामपि दृश्यत इति दीर्घः । कृत्स्वरः । तरुणीषु । नञ्

> *kenāpi puruṣeṇāniṣiktaretaskā anabhyaktā vā aṃtavartatīragninā garbhavatyo bhūtvā*
> *suvate | phalaṃ puṣpaṃ cotpādayaṃti | tadidaṃ devānāmaiśvaryaṃ ||*
> *ākṣit | kṣi nivāsagatyoḥ | kvip | anūrut | anau rudha kāme | asmāt kvip | anveṣāmapi dṛśyata iti*
> *dīrghaḥ | kṛtsvaraḥ | taruṇīṣu | nañ*

Summary

Agni, or Sūrya, abiding (आक्षित् (*ākṣit*)) in the old, decayed herbs, and likewise following (अनूरुत् (*anūrut*)) the new herbs, acting in accord with their origin, is within the herbs that have just been born (सद्यो जातासु (*sadyo jātāsu*)), that is, newly arisen, young and sprouted. Those herbs are अप्रवीताः (*apravītāḥ*) … (the text of the block breaks off here; the next window continues).

Sāyaṇa completes the verse's explanation. Those plants, without having been impregnated by any male, or unanointed, are filled within by Agni and become pregnant. They bear fruit and produce flowers. This is the lordship of the gods.

Word-to-word meaning

- पूर्वासु (*pūrvāsu*)—in the ancient plants
- आक्षित् (*ākṣit*)—Agni, who had pervaded
- अपराः (*aparāḥ*)—in the new plants
- अनूरुत् (*anūrut*)—enters (afterwards)
- सद्यो जातासु (*sadyo jātāsu*)—in those just produced
- तरुणीषु (*taruṇīṣu*)—in the plants in the form of shoots
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—enters within
- अप्रवीताः (*apravītāḥ*)—even though there is no contact with a male
- अंतर्वतीः (*aṃtarvatīḥ*)—those plants that bear a womb (embryo)
- सुवते (*suvate*)—bear flowers and the like
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Agni, who had pervaded the ancient plants, comes to be within the new plants. Those plants, becoming pregnant even without contact with a male, bear flowers and fruits. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Existing in ancient plants, abiding afterwards in new, he enters into the young (herbs) as soon as they are produced : unimpregnated they be- come pregnant and bear fruit : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the feminine words पूर्वासु (*pūrvāsu*) अपराः (*aparāḥ*), जातासु (*jātāsu*), तरुणेषु (*taruṇeṣu*), अंतर्वतीः (*aṃtarvatīḥ*) are used, and also the verbal forms अक्षित् (*akṣit*) and अनूरुत् (*anūrut*). In describing the greatness of Agni or Sūrya, who performs actions so that the growth of the world may be continuous, the juxtaposition of the words used here describes, by transfer and in the manner of poetry, the story of a householder, or of a lover, who carries on the life of the world. As a lustful man abandons an aged woman, Agni abandons पूर्वासु आक्षित् जीर्णासु ओषधीषु आवर्तमानः (*pūrvāsu ākṣit jīrṇāsu oṣadhīṣu āvartamānaḥ*), the plants that are very old and withering;

and अपराः अनुरुत्—नव्याः ओषदीः उत्पत्यानुगुण्येन अनु तिष्ठन् (*aparāḥ anurut—navyāḥ oṣadīḥ utpatyānuguṇyena anu tiṣṭhan*): he follows the tender herbs that are newly growing and radiant, in keeping with their growth. By this too the conduct of a lover is understood.

जातासु तरुणीषु अंतः—तदानीं उत्कन्नासु पल्लवितासु ओषधीषु अंतः वर्तते (*jātāsu taruṇīṣu aṃtaḥ—tadānīṃ utkannāsu pallavitāsu oṣadhīṣu aṃtaḥ vartate*): he abides within the herbs that have just then been born and are furnished with new sprouts, remaining inside them so that they may grow, and nourishing them. Thus the greatness of Agni is stated: he is the cause of the origin, continuance and dissolution of plants.

But the herbs, like women in the world, obtain flowers, fruits and the like even without connection with a male; since such a making is the work of the gods, the might of the gods is described as extraordinary.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

श॒युः प॒रस्ता॒दध॒ नु द्वि॑मा॒ताब॑न्ध॒नश्च॑रति व॒त्स ए
क॑ः ।
मि॒त्रस्य॒ ता वरु॑णस्य व्र॒तानि॑ म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे
क॑म् ॥ ६ ॥

> *śayuḥ parastādadha nu dvimātābandhanaścarati vatsa ekaḥ |*
> *mitrasya tā varuṇasya vratāni mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शयुः । परस्तात् । अध । नु । द्विमाता । अबंधनः । चरति । वत्सः । एकः ।
> मित्रस्य । ता । वरुणस्य । व्रतानि । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ६ ॥

> *śayuḥ | parastāt | adha | nu | dvimātā | abaṃdhanaḥ | carati | vatsaḥ | ekaḥ |*
> *mitrasya | tā | varuṇasya | vratāni | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> द्विमाता । हे द्यावापृथिव्यौ मातरौ यस्य स द्विमाता । यद्वा । ध्वयोर्लोकयोर्निमार्ता सूर्यः परस्तात्पश्चिमायां दिश्यस्तवेलायां।शयुः शयानोऽव्याप्रियमाणो भवति । अध नु अथोदयवेलायामेको द्यावापृथिव्यो 8
> साधारणस्तयो रसादानाद्वत्सः पुत्रोऽबंधनोऽप्रतिबद्धगतिरनालंबन एकः सन् चरति । नभसि गच्छति । ता तानीमानि मित्रस्य वरुणस्य मित्रावरुणयोर्व्रतानि कर्माणि।
> शयुः । शीज् स्वप्ने । भृमृशीत्य चरीत्यादिना उप्रत्ययः । द्विमाता । नद्यृतश्चेति प्राप्तस्य कप ऋतश्चंदसीति प्रतिषेधः ॥

> *dvimātā | he dyāvāpṛthivyau mātarau yasya sa dvimātā | yadvā |*
> *dhvayorlokayornimārtā sūryaḥ parastātpaścimāyāṃ diśyastavelāyāṃ|*
> *śayuḥ śayāno 'vyāpriyamāṇo bhavati | adha nu athodayavelāyāmeko*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyo 8*
> *sādhāraṇastayo rasādānādvatsaḥ putro 'baṃdhano*
> *'pratibaddhagatiranālaṃbana ekaḥ san*
> *carati | nabhasi gacchati | tā tānīmāni mitrasya varuṇasya*
> *mitrāvaruṇayorvratāni karmāṇi|*
> *śayuḥ | śīj svapne | bhṛmṛśītya carītyādinā upratyayaḥ | dvimātā |*
> *nadyṛtaśceti*
> *prāptasya kapa ṛtaścaṃdasīti pratiṣedhaḥ ||*

Summary

द्विमाता (*dvimātā*): he whose two mothers are heaven and earth. Or else, he who is the maker of the two worlds: Sūrya. परस्तात् (*parastāt*): in the western quarter, at the time of setting, he is शयुः (*śayuḥ*), lying down, not active. अध नु (*adha nu*): then, at the time of rising, the one calf, common to heaven and earth, their son because he draws their sap, अबंधनः (*abaṃdhanaḥ*), with unobstructed course and without support, being alone, चरति (*carati*), moves in the sky. ता (*tā*): these are the व्रतानि (*vratāni*), the works, of Mitra and Varuṇa, of Mitra-and-Varuṇa.

Word-to-word meaning

- द्विमाता (*dvimātā*)—Āditya, who has both heaven and earth as mother
- परस्तात् (*parastāt*)—in the western quarter
- शयुः (*śayuḥ*)—is laid to rest
- अध नु (*adha nu*)—afterwards (at the time of rising)
- एकः (*ekaḥ*)—the one common (to both heaven and earth)
- वत्सः (*vatsaḥ*)—son (Āditya)
- अबंधनः (*abaṃdhanaḥ*)—having an unhindered course
- चरति (*carati*)—moves in the sky
- ता (*tā*)—all these goings and comings (of Āditya)
- मित्रस्य (*mitrasya*)—of Mitra (and)
- वरुणस्य (*varuṇasya*)—of Varuṇa

- व्रतानि (*vratāni*)—are the works
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Āditya, who has both heaven and earth as mother, is laid to rest in the western quarter. Afterwards, at the time of rising, the son (Āditya), common to both heaven and earth, moves in the sky with unhindered course. All these goings and comings of Āditya are the works of Mitra and Varuṇa. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

The child of two mothers sleeps in the west, but (in the morning) the single infant proceeds unobstructed (through the sky) : these are the functions of Mitra and Varuna : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

द्विमाता परस्तात् शयुः (*dvimātā parastāt śayuḥ*)—द्वे द्यावापृथिव्यौ मातरौ यस्य सः (*dve dyāvāpṛthivyau mātarau yasya saḥ*). यदा द्वयोर्लोकयोः निर्माता (*yadā dvayorlokayoḥ nirmātā*). Sūrya has both heaven and earth as mother. Since heaven and earth have granted room to the whole world, they are said to be mothers of Sūrya also. Or else, since Sūrya is the protector of the two worlds, earth and the middle region, he is the maker of the two worlds; thus a second meaning is described. That at the time of setting this Sūrya is without the spreading of his rays is the meaning stated by the words शयुः शयानः (*śayuḥ śayānaḥ*).

एकः अबंधनः वत्सः चरति (*ekaḥ abaṃdhanaḥ vatsaḥ carati*)—Sāyaṇa has explained this sentence in two ways. First: द्यावापृथिव्योः साधारणः तयोः रसादानात् पुत्रः अप्रतिबद्धगतिः नभसि चरति (*dyāvāpṛthivyoḥ sādhāraṇaḥ tayoḥ rasādānāt putraḥ apratibaddhagatiḥ nabhasi carati*). Since Sūrya draws up the waters in earth and the middle region, he stands in an equal relation to both of them, heaven and earth, and this Sūrya moves in the middle region without any obstruction; thus the meaning is explained. In the second meaning, this Sūrya is अनालंबनः (*anālaṃbanaḥ*), without any support, and moves alone in the middle region (so that he does not fall down); thus it is described.

That heaven and earth are described as the mother-hood of Sūrya; that at setting Sūrya becomes lustreless, without the spreading of his rays; that, drawing the sap of heaven and earth (as if drinking milk), he has the state of a son; and that he moves in the middle region as if unobstructed and without any support: all these acts are the acts of Mitra and Varuṇa, and the might of these gods is described as full of greatness and pre-eminent.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

द्वि॒मा॒ता होता॑ वि॒दथे॑षु स॒म्राळन्व॒ग्रं चर॑ति॒ क्षेति॑ बु॒ध्नः ।
प्र रण्या॑नि रण्य॒वाचो॑ भरन्ते म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ ७ ॥

> *dvimātā hotā vidatheṣu samrāḷanvagraṃ carati kṣeti budhnaḥ |*
> *pra raṇyāni raṇyavāco bharante mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> द्विमाता । होता । विदथेषु । सम्राट् । अनु । अग्रं । चरति । क्षेति । बुध्नः ।
> प्र । रण्यानि । रण्यवाचः । भरंते । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ७ ॥

> *dvimātā | hotā | vidatheṣu | samrāṭ | anu | agraṃ | carati | kṣeti | budhnaḥ |*
> *pra | raṇyāni | raṇyavācaḥ | bharaṃte | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> द्विमाता द्वयोर्लोकयोर्निर्माता विदथेषु यज्ञेषु होता देवानामाह्वाता सम्राट् यज्ञेषु
> सम्यग्राजमानोऽग्निरन्नग्रमग्रे दिवि चरति । सूर्यभूतस्तत्र वर्तते । बुध्नः सर्वस्य कर्मणो
> मूलभूततः सन् क्षेति । भूम् वसति ।
> यद्वा । अग्रं मुख्यं भागं चरति । भक्षयति । क्षेति । यज्वनां गृहेषु निवसति ।
> यद्वा । बुद्धः प्रतिष्ठांतेभागी स्विष्टकृद्रूपेण । प्रतिष्ठा वै स्विष्टकृदिति श्रुतेः ।
> किंच रण्यवाचो रमणीयवाचः स्तोतारो रण्यानि रमणीयानि स्तोत्राणि प्र
> भरंते । प्रणयंति । कुर्वंति । तदिदं देवानामैश्वर्यं । चरति । चादिलोप इति न
> निघातः ॥

> *dvimātā dvayorlokayornirmātā vidatheṣu yajñeṣu hotā devānāmāhvātā samrāṭ yajñeṣu samyagrājamāno 'gnirannagramagre divi carati | sūryabhūtastatra vartate | budhnaḥ sarvasya karmaṇo mūlabhūtataḥ san kṣeti | bhūm vasati |*
> *yadvā | agraṃ mukhyaṃ bhāgaṃ carati | bhakṣayati | kṣeti | yajvanāṃ gṛheṣu nivasati |*
> *yadvā | buddhaḥ pratiṣṭhāṃtebhāgī sviṣṭakṛdrūpeṇa | pratiṣṭhā vai sviṣṭakṛditi śruteḥ |*
> *kiṃca raṇyavāco ramaṇīyavācaḥ stotāro raṇyāni ramaṇīyāni stotrāṇi pra*
> *bharaṃte | praṇayaṃti | kurvaṃti | tadidaṃ devānāmaiśvaryaṃ | carati | cādilopa iti na*
> *nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

द्विमाता (*dvimātā*): the maker of the two worlds. विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*): in sacrifices होता (*hotā*), the caller of the gods; सम्राट् (*samrāṭ*): Agni, shining well in the sacrifices, अन्वग्रं चरति (*anvagraṃ carati*), moves first in the sky; being Sūrya, he abides there. बुध्नः (*budhnaḥ*): being the root of all action, क्षेति (*kṣeti*): he dwells on earth. Or else: अग्रं (*agraṃ*) means the principal portion, and चरति (*carati*) means he eats it; क्षेति (*kṣeti*): he dwells in the houses of sacrificers. Or else: बुद्धः (*buddhaḥ*) (read thus) is प्रतिष्ठा (*pratiṣṭhā*), the sharer at the end in the form of Sviṣṭakṛt, from the Śruti प्रतिष्ठा वै स्विष्टकृदिति श्रुतेः (*pratiṣṭhā vai sviṣṭakṛditi śruteḥ*). Moreover, the रण्यवाचः (*raṇyavācaḥ*), reciters of pleasing speech, प्र भरंते (*pra bharaṃte*), compose and offer रण्यानि (*raṇyāni*), pleasing praises. This is the lordship of the gods.

Word-to-word meaning

- द्विमाता (*dvimātā*)—he who has both heaven and earth as mother
- विदथेषु (*vidadheṣu*)—in sacrifices
- होता (*hotā*)—the caller of the gods
- सम्राट् (*samrāṭ*)—and the shining one, Agni
- अन्वग्रं (*anvagraṃ*)—at the forepart of the middle region
- चरति (*carati*)—moves (in the form of Sūrya)
- बुद्धः (*buddhaḥ*)—being the root of all actions
- क्षेति (*kṣeti*)—dwells on the earth
- रण्यवाचः (*raṇyavācaḥ*)—reciters with pleasing speech
- रण्यानि (*raṇyāni*)—pleasing praises
- प्र भरंते (*pra bharaṃtè*)—make in abundance
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Agni, who has both heaven and earth as mother, who calls the gods at sacrifices, and who is shining, moves at the forepart of the middle region in the form of Sūrya. Being the root of all actions, he dwells on the earth. Reciters with pleasing speech make pleasing praises. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

The child of two mothers, thc invoker of the gods at sacrifices, the universal sovereign, proceeds thenceforward (in the sky) : the root (of all), he abides (in the houses of the pious) : the reciters of pleasant (words) offer him agreeable (praises) : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

Agni is द्वयोर्लोकयो निर्माता (*dvayorlokayo nirmātā*), the maker of the two worlds, earth and the middle region; therefore he is designated by the word द्विमाता (*dvimātā*). Since he brings the gods to accept the oblation, he is the Hotṛ. Since he shines greatly with radiance in the sacrifices, he is the sovereign. And since he is the root cause of all actions, he is described in this Ṛk as बुद्धः (*buddhaḥ*).

अन्वग्रं चरति—अग्रे दिवि सूर्यभूतस्तत्र वर्तते (*anvagraṃ carati—agre divi sūryabhūtastatra vartate*): Agni shines in the middle region as Sūrya. Having thus described the identity of Agni with Sūrya, Sāyaṇa describes a second meaning: अग्रं मुख्यं भागं चरति भक्षयति (*agraṃ mukhyaṃ bhāgaṃ carati bhakṣayati*), Agni, the chief cause of all actions, eats the principal portions of the oblation in the sacrifices.

बुद्धः क्षेति—सर्वस्य कर्मणो मूलभूतस्सन् भूमौ वसति यद्वा यज्वनां गृहेषु निवसति (*buddhaḥ kṣeti—sarvasya karmaṇo mūlabhūtassan bhūmau vasati yadvā yajvanāṃ gṛheṣu nivasati*): Agni, being the root cause of all actions, dwells on the earth

or else dwells in the houses of those devoted to sacrifice; thus two meanings are explained.

And बुद्धः प्रतिष्ठा अंते भागी स्विष्टकृद्रूपेण (*buddhaḥ pratiṣṭhā aṃte bhāgī sviṣṭakṛdrūpeṇa*): by the homa called Sviṣṭakṛt, performed in sacrifices, he receives the oblation offered at the end. Therefore Agni is described as the one who establishes stability. For the meaning प्रतिष्ठौ (*pratiṣṭhau*) of the word बुद्ध (*buddha*), the Śruti sentence “प्रतिष्ठौ वै स्विष्टकृत् (*pratiṣṭhau vai sviṣṭakṛt*)” is cited.

रण्यवाचः रण्यानि प्रभरंते—रमणीयवाचः स्तोत्रारः रमणीयानि स्तोत्राणि प्रकर्षेण कुर्वंति (*raṇyavācaḥ raṇyāni prabharaṃte—ramaṇīyavācaḥ stotrāraḥ ramaṇīyāni stotrāṇi prakarṣeṇa kurvaṃti*). रणौ रमणीयौ सांग्राम्यावा (*raṇau ramaṇīyau sāṃgrāmyāvā*) (Ni. 6-24): the word रण (*raṇa*) has been explained by Yāska, meaning that they recite pleasing praises.

That Agni exists in identity with Sūrya and is the root cause of all actions, and other such things, are the principal glories of the gods and remain in might; thus it is described.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शूर॑स्येव॒ युध्य॑तो अन्त॒मस्य॑ प्रती॒चीनं॑ ददृशे॒ विश्व॑मा॒यत् ।
अ॒न्तर्म॒तिश्च॑रति नि॒ष्षिधं॒ गोर्म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ ८ ॥

> *śūrasyeva yudhyato antamasya pratīcīnaṃ dadṛśe viśvamāyat |*
> *antarmatiścarati niṣṣidhaṃ gormahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शूरस्य इव । युध्यतः । अंतमस्य । प्रतीचीनं । ददृशे । विश्वं । आयत् ।
> अंतः । मतिः । चरति । निःसिधं । गोः । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ८ ॥

> *śūrasya iva | yudhyataḥ | aṃtamasya | pratīcīnaṃ | dadṛśe | viśvaṃ | āyat |*
> *aṃtaḥ | matiḥ | carati | niḥsidhaṃ | goḥ | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अंतमस्य समीपे वर्तमानस्य दावाग्नेरायदभिमुखमागच्छद्विश्वं भूतजातं प्रतिचीनं पराङ्मुखं ददृशे । दृश्यते । तत्र दृष्टांतः । शूरस्येव । यथा
> युध्यतो युद्धं कुर्वाणस्य शूरस्य समर्थस्य राज्णोऽभिमुखमागच्छत्परबलं
> पराङ्मुखं दृश्यते तद्वत् । मतिः सर्वैर्ज्ञायमानः सोऽग्निर्गोरुदकस्य निष्पिधं
> हिंसिकां दीप्तिमंतश्च रति । अंतर्धारयति ॥ युध्यतः । युध संप्रहारे । दिवादिः ।

> *aṃtamasya samīpe vartamānasya*
> *dāvāgnerāyadabhimukhamāgacchadviśvaṃ bhūtajātaṃ praticīnaṃ*
> *parāṅmukhaṃ dadṛśe | dṛśyate | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | śūrasyeva | yathā*
> *yudhyato yuddhaṃ kurvāṇasya śūrasya samarthasya rājṇo*
> *'bhimukhamāgacchatparabalaṃ*
> *parāṅmukhaṃ dṛśyate tadvat | matiḥ sarvairjñāyamānaḥ so*

> *'gnirgorudakasya niṣpidhaṃ*
> *hiṃsikāṃ dīptimaṃtaśca rati | aṃtardhārayati ‖ yudhyataḥ | yudha saṃprahāre | divādiḥ |*

> तस्य शतरि रूपं । अंतमस्य । अंतशब्दादत इनिठनाविति ठन् । अतिशयेनांतिक इत्यर्थे
> तमस् । तमेः तादेश्येति तादिलोपः । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । प्रतीचीनं । प्रतिपूर्वस्यांचतेः क्विन्
> । तस्माद्विभाषांचेरदिक्स्त्रियामिति खः । ईनादेशः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ।
> आयत् । या प्रापण इत्यस्याज् पूर्वस्य शतरि रूपं आज्पूर्वस्य अय पय गतावित्यस्य शतरि रूपं वेति व्युत्पत्त्यनवधारणादनवग्रहः ॥

> *tasya śatari rūpaṃ | aṃtamasya | aṃtaśabdādata iniṭhanāviti ṭhan | atiśayenāṃtika ityarthe*
> *tamas | tamèḥ tādeśyeti tādilopaḥ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ | pratīcīnaṃ | pratipūrvasyāṃcateḥ kvin | tasmādvibhāṣāṃceradikstriyāmiti khaḥ | īnādeśaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*
> *āyat | yā prāpaṇa ityasyāj pūrvasya śatari rūpaṃ ājpūrvasya aya paya gatāvityasya śatari rūpaṃ veti vyutpattyanavadhāraṇādanavagrahaḥ ‖*

Summary

अंतमस्य (*aṃtamasya*): of the forest fire that stands near; the whole creation coming towards it (आयत् (*āyat*), advancing to meet it) is seen प्रतिचीनं (*praticīnaṃ*), turned away, ददृशे (*dadṛśe*), is seen. The illustration is शूरस्येव (*śūrasyeva*): as the hostile army coming to meet a brave, capable king who is fighting a battle is seen turned away, so here. मतिः (*matiḥ*): that Agni, known by all, holds within himself (Sāyaṇa: अंतर्धारयति (*aṃtardhārayati*)) गोः (*goḥ*), of the cow (that is, of water), the destructive निष्पिधं (*niṣpidhaṃ*) radiance. This is the lordship of the gods (as in the refrain).

This block gives only the grammatical derivations of the words of the preceding bhāṣya; the Grammar section carries them. It ends by saying that, because the derivation is not settled, no definite choice (anavagraha) is made for आयत् (*āyat*): it may be the present participle of या प्रापण (*yā prāpaṇa*) with आज् (*āj*) before it, or of the root अय पय (*aya paya*) (to go) with आज् (*āj*) before it.

Word-to-word meaning

- अंतमस्य (*aṃtamasya*)—of the nearby forest fire

- आयत् (*āyat*)—going towards
- विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)—all beings too
- युध्यतः (*yudhyataḥ*)—of the one who fights
- शूरस्येव (*śūrasyeva*)—as enemy armies turn their backs and run on seeing a hero
- प्रतीचीनं (*pratīcīnaṃ*)—turned away
- ददृशे (*dadṛśe*)—appear
- मतिः (*matiḥ*)—Agni, who is known by all
- गोः (*goḥ*)—of the water
- निष्पिधं (*niṣpidhaṃ*)—radiant
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the interior
- चरति (*carati*)—moves
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and ordinary[?116]

Gist

All beings approaching the nearby forest fire appear turned away, just as enemy armies turn their backs and flee on seeing a fighting hero. Agni, known to all, moves in the radiant interior of the water. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

All (creatures) approaching too near his confines are beheld with their faces turned away as (an enemy) flies from a combatant : obvious (to all), he penetrates the water for its destruction : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

अंतमस्य—समीपे वर्तमानस्य (*aṃtamasya—samīpe vartamānasya*). This word is used as an adjective. Following the meaning of the comparison sentence, Sāyaṇa explains the noun qualified as the forest fire. शूरस्य युद्धतः आयत् विश्वं प्रतीचीनं ददृशे (*śūrasya yuddhataḥ āyat viśvaṃ pratīcīnaṃ dadṛśe*)—यथा युद्धं कुर्वाणस्य शूरस्य समर्थस्य राज्ञः अभिमुखमागच्छत् भूतजातं परबलं पराङ्मुखं दृश्यते (*yathā yuddhaṃ kurvāṇasya* *śūrasya samarthasya rājñaḥ abhimukhamāgacchat bhūtajātaṃ parabalaṃ parāṅmukhaṃ dṛśyate*)—as an enemy army that has come to face a king engaged in battle turns back through the king's power, so, with समीपे वर्तमानस्य दावाग्नेः विश्वं प्रतीचीनं ददृशे (*samīpe vartamānasya dāvāgneḥ viśvaṃ pratīcīnaṃ dadṛśe*)—all who come to confront the fiercely blazing forest fire, unable to extinguish it, turn back; thus the incomparable greatness of the forest fire is described.

The word मतिः (*matiḥ*) is explained as सर्वैः ज्ञायमानः (*sarvaiḥ jñāyamānaḥ*): Agni is known to all by his own natural quality. This Agni गोः निष्पिधं अंतश्चरति (*goḥ niṣpidhaṃ aṃtaścarati*)—उदकस्य हिंसिकां दीप्तिं अंतर्धारयति (*udakasya hiṃsikāṃ dīptiṃ aṃtardhārayati*)—he bears even in the midst of the waters the abundant radiance (power) that drinks up the waters; thus the Aurvāgni (the fire in the earth) is described briefly. So in this Ṛk both the forest fire and the Aurvāgni are described briefly. The abundant might of the gods, being such, is described as unequalled.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नि वें॑वेति पलि॒तो दू॒त आ॑स्व॒न्तर्म॒हाँश्चं॑रति रोच॒नेनं॑ ।
वपूं॑षि॒ बिभ्रं॑द॒भि नो॒ वि चं॑ष्टे म॒हद्दे॒वानां॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेकं॑म् ॥ ९ ॥

> *ni veveti palito dūta āsvantarmahā~ścarati rocanena |*
> *vapūṃṣi bibhradabhi no vi caṣṭe mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नि । वेवेति । पलितः । दूतः । आसु । अंतः । महान् । च र ति । रोचनेन ।
> वपूंषि । बिभ्रत् । अभि । नः । वि । चष्टे । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥९॥

> *ni | veveti | palitaḥ | dūtaḥ | āsu | aṃtaḥ | mahān | ca ra ti | rocanena |*
> *vapūṃṣi | bibhrat | abhi | naḥ | vi | caṣṭe | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖9‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पलितः पालयिता पूर्णो वा देवानां दूतोऽग्निरास्वोषधीषु नि वेवेति ।
> नितरां वाप्य वर्तते । महान् सोऽग्नी रोचनेन सूर्येण सहांता रोदस्योर्मद्ये चरति । वपूंषि नानाविधानि रूपाणि बिभ्रत् सोऽग्निर्नोऽस्मान् यष्द्वानभि
> वि चष्टे । विशेषेणानुग्रहदृष्ट्या पश्यति ॥ वेवेति । वी गत्यादिषु । यज्ञलुकि ईडभावे रूपं । रोचनेन ! सहार्थे तृतीया । भिभ्रत् । डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्य शतरि रूपं । अभ्यस्तस्वरः ॥

> *palitaḥ pālayitā pūrṇo vā devānāṃ dūto 'gnirāsvoṣadhīṣu ni veveti |*
> *nitarāṃ vāpya vartate | mahān so 'gnī rocanena sūryeṇa sahāṃtā rodasyormadyė carati | vapūṃṣi nānāvidhāni rūpāṇi bibhrat so 'gnirno 'smān yaṣṭvānabhi*
> *vi caṣṭe | viśeṣeṇānugrahadṛṣṭyā paśyati ‖ veveti | vī gatyādiṣu | yajjaluki īḍabhāve rūpaṃ | rocanena ! sahārthe tṛtīyā | bhibhrat | ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasya śatari rūpaṃ | abhyastasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

पलितः (*palitaḥ*) means protector, or full. Agni, the messenger of the gods, नि वेवेति (*ni veveti*) constantly abides in these plants. Being great, he moves with रोचनेन (*rocanena*), the sun, between heaven and earth. Bearing manifold forms (वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)), he looks upon us, the sacrificers, वि चष्टे (*vi caṣṭe*), with a particularly favouring eye. (Remaining text: grammar of वेवेति (*veveti*), रोचनेन (*rocanena*) (third case in the sense of "together with") and भिभ्रत् (*bhibhrat*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- पलितः (*palitaḥ*)—the full-natured
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—Agni, the messenger of the gods
- आसु (*āsu*)—in these plants
- नि वेवेति (*ni veveti*)—has pervaded
- महान् (*mahān*)—the great Agni

- रोचनेन (*rocanena*)—as the shining sun
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—between heaven and earth
- चरति (*carati*)—moves
- वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)—manifold forms
- बिभ्रत् (*bibhrat*)—Agni who bears
- नः (*naḥ*)—us, the sacrificers
- अभि वि चष्टे (*abhi vi caṣṭe*)—looks upon with a favouring eye
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Agni, full-natured and messenger of the gods, has pervaded these plants. The great Agni, as the shining sun, moves between heaven and earth. Bearing manifold forms, he looks upon us, the sacrificers, with a favouring eye. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

In those (plants) the aged messenger (of the gods) constantly abides : mighty, he passes with the radiant (sun) thorough the regions of space ; assuming various forms, he looks (complacently) upon us : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

पलितः— पालयिता पूर्णो वा (*palitaḥ— pālayitā pūrṇo vā*). Agni is explained as the protector of all, or as full with complete greatness. He is also described as देवानां दूतः (*devānāṃ dūtaḥ*), messenger of the gods, because he calls the gods to the sacrificial hall to receive the oblation and carries each god's oblation to him. By the sentence मर्हा रोचनेन अंतः चरति (*marhā rocanena aṃtaḥ carati*) Agni, full of greatness, is described as moving with the sun between heaven and earth. But in Ṛk (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-75-7) the identity with the sun and a separate movement are described. This Agni, वपूंषि बिभ्रत् नः अभि वि चष्टे (*vapūṃṣi bibhrat naḥ abhi vi caṣṭe*), bearing various forms, looks upon us the sacrificers greatly favouringly.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

विष्णु॑र्गो॒पाः प॑र॒मं पा॑ति॒ पाथ॑ः प्रि॒या धामा॑न्य॒मृता॒ दधा॑नः ।
अ॒ग्निष्टा विश्वा॒ भुव॑नानि वेद म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म्
॥ १० ॥

> *viṣṇurgopāḥ paramaṃ pāti pāthaḥ priyā dhāmānyamṛtā dadhānaḥ |*
> *agniṣṭā viśvā bhuvanāni veda mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विष्णुः । गोपाः । परमं । पाति । पाथः । प्रिया । धामानि । अमृता । दधानः ।
> अग्निः । ता । विश्वा । भुवनानि । वेद । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ १० ॥

> *viṣṇuḥ | gopāḥ | paramaṃ | pāti | pāthaḥ | priyā | dhāmāni | amṛtā | dadhānaḥ |*
> *agniḥ | tā | viśvā | bhuvanāni | veda | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विष्णुर्वाप्नो गोपाः सर्वस्य गोपायिता प्रिया प्रियतमान्यमृता क्षयरहितानि धामानि तेजांसि दधानः सोऽग्निः परमं पाथः स्थानं पाति । रक्षति । यद्वा ।
> धामानि लोकधारकाण्यमृतोदकानि दधानः सन् परमं पाथ उदकस्य स्थानमंतरिक्षं पाति । सोऽग्निस्ता तानि विश्वा सर्वाणि भुवनानि भूतजातानि वेद । जानाति ॥ गोपाः । गोपायतेः क्विप्यतोलोपयलोपौ । अग्निष्टेत्यत्र संहितायां युष्मत्तत्तत्कुः स्वंतः पादमिति षत्वं ॥

> *viṣṇurvāpno gopāḥ sarvasya gopāyitā priyā priyatamānyamṛtā kṣayarahitāni dhāmāni tejāṃsi dadhānaḥ so 'gniḥ paramaṃ pāthaḥ sthānaṃ pāti | rakṣati | yadvā |*
> *dhāmāni lokadhārakāṇyamṛtodakāni dadhānaḥ san paramaṃ pātha udakasya sthānamaṃtarikṣaṃ*
> *pāti | so 'gnistā tāni viśvā sarvāṇi bhuvanāni bhūtajātāni veda | jānāti ‖*

> *gopāḥ |*
> *gopāyateḥ kvipyatolopayalopau | agniṣṭetyatra saṃhitāyāṃ*
> *yuṣmattattatkuḥ*
> *svaṃtaḥ pādamiti ṣatvaṃ ||*

Summary

विष्णुः (*viṣṇuḥ*) is the pervader and गोपाः (*gopāḥ*) the protector of all. Bearing most dear (प्रिया (*priyā*)) and imperishable (अमृता (*amṛtā*)) splendours (धामानि (*dhāmāni*)), that Agni guards the highest place (परमं पाथः (*paramaṃ pāthaḥ*)). Or else: bearing the world-sustaining immortal waters, he guards the supreme place of water, the atmosphere. That Agni knows all those beings (भुवनानि (*bhuvanāni*)). (Remaining text: grammar of गोपाः (*gopāḥ*) and the change to ṣ in अग्निष्टा (*agniṣṭā*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- विष्णुः (*viṣṇuḥ*)—the all-pervading
- गोपाः (*gopāḥ*)—the protector of all
- प्रिया (*priyā*)—most dear
- अमृता (*amṛtā*)—imperishable
- धामानि (*dhāmāni*)—splendours
- दधानः (*dadhānaḥ*)—possessing; Agni
- परमं पाथः (*paramaṃ pāthaḥ*)—the highest path
- पाति (*pāti*)—protects
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—that same Agni
- ता विश्वा भुवनानि (*tā viśvā bhuvanāni*)—all those well-known worlds
- वेद (*veda*)—knows
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Agni, who is all-pervading, protector of all, and possessor of most dear and imperishable splendours, protects the highest path. He knows all the worlds. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Pervading and protecting (all), possesing grateful and immortal radiance, he preserves the supreme path (of the rains), for Agni knows all these worlds : great and unqueualled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

विष्णुः गोपाः अमृता धामानि दधानः—व्याप्तः सर्वस्य गोपायिता क्षयरहितानि तेजांसि दधानः (*viṣṇuḥ gopāḥ amṛtā dhāmāni dadhānaḥ—vyāptaḥ sarvasya gopāyitā kṣayarahitāni tejāṃsi dadhānaḥ*): Agni pervades everything, protects all, and bears splendours that are ever without decline—this is one kind of meaning; in it धामानि (*dhāmāni*) is explained as splendours. In the second meaning धामानि (*dhāmāni*) is said to be लोकधारकाणि (*lokadhārakāṇi*) and अमृता (*amṛtā*) waters. Hence लोकधारकाणि उदकानि दधानः अग्निः उदकस्य स्थानमंतरिक्षं पाति (*lokadhārakāṇi udakāni dadhānaḥ agniḥ udakasya sthānamaṃtarikṣaṃ pāti*)—Agni, bearing the world-sustaining waters, protects the atmosphere, the place of the waters. The word अमृत (*amṛta*) is stated by Yāska among the names of water (Ni. 2-24).

सः अग्निः विश्वा भुवनानि वेद—सर्वाणि भूतजातानि जानाति (*saḥ agniḥ viśvā bhuvanāni veda—sarvāṇi bhūtajātāni jānāti*). The word भुवन (*bhuvana*) is given the meaning "living beings"; because Agni knows all the manifold beings, he is described as omniscient. Thus Jātavedas Agni is described in another manner. So in the preceding Ṛks Agni's manifold existence—as lightning-fire, Vaiśvānara fire, forest fire, Aurva fire—has been described briefly.

Ṛk 11

Samhitā-pāṭha

नाना॑ चक्राते य॒म्या॒३॒॑ वपूं॑षि॒ तयो॑र॒न्यद्रोचं॑ते कृ॒ष्णम॒
न्यत् ।
श्यावीं॑ च॒ यदरुं॑षी च॒ स्वसा॑रौ म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे
कं॑म् ॥ ११ ॥

> *nānā cakrāte yamyā vapūṃṣi tayoranyadrocate kṛṣṇamanyat |*
> *śyāvī ca yadaruṣī ca svasārau mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नाना । चक्राते इति । यम्या । वपूंषि । तयोः । अन्यत् । रोचते । कृष्णं । अन्यत् ।
> श्यावी । च । यत् । अरुषी । च । स्वसारौ । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥

> *nānā | cakrāte iti | yamyā | vapūṃṣi | tayoḥ | anyat | rocate | kṛṣṇaṃ |*
> *anyat |*
> *śyāvī | ca | yat | aruṣī | ca | svasārau | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ*
> *| ekaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यम्या यमरूपे मिथुनभूते अहश्च रात्रिश्चेत्येते नाना नानाविधानि
> वपूंषि शुक्लकृष्णादीनि रूपाणि चक्राते । कुरुतः । श्यावी कृष्णवर्णारुषी शुक्लतयारोचमाना
> यत् ये परस्परं स्वसारौ भवतस्तयोर्मध्येऽन्यदर्जुनमहो
> रोचते । किरणसंबंधाद्दीप्यते । अन्यद्रात्रिलक्षणं कृष्णं तमस्संबंधात् कृष्णवर्णमाभाति ॥
> यम्या । सुपो डादेशः । रोचते । एकान्याभ्यां समर्थाभ्यामिति न
> निघातः ॥

> *yamyā yamarūpe mithunabhūte ahaśca rātriścetyete nānā nānāvidhāni*
> *vapūṃṣi śuklakṛṣṇādīni rūpāṇi cakrāte | kurutaḥ | śyāvī kṛṣṇavarṇāruṣī*
> *śuklatayārocamānā yat ye parasparaṃ svasārau bhavatastayormadhye*
> *'nyadarjunamaho*
> *rocate | kiraṇasaṃbaṃdhādvīpyate | anyadrātrilakṣaṇaṃ kṛṣṇaṃ*

> *tamassaṃbaṃdhāt kṛṣṇavarṇamābhāti ‖ yamyā | supo ḍādeśaḥ | rocate | ekānyābhyāṃ samarthābhyāmiti na nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

यम्या (*yamyā*), the twin pair, day and night, चक्राते (*cakrāte*) make manifold (नाना (*nānā*)) forms (वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)), white, black and so on. श्यावी (*śyāvī*) is the black-coloured one and अरुषी (*aruṣī*) the one shining through whiteness; as the two are sisters (स्वसारौ (*svasārau*)) of each other, of them one, the bright day, रोचते (*rocate*) shines through its connection with the rays; the other, characterised as night, appears black through its connection with darkness. (Remaining text: grammar of यम्या (*yamyā*) (ḍā substitution) and रोचते (*rocate*) (no nighāta).)

Word-to-word meaning

- यम्या (*yamyā*)—day and night as a pair
- नाना (*nānā*)—manifold (white and black)
- वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)—forms
- चक्राते (*cakrāte*)—have assumed
- श्यावी (*śyāvī*)—the black-coloured night
- अरुषी (*aruṣī*)—the day full of light
- यत् स्वसारौ (*yat svasārau*)—they are sisters of each other
- तयोः (*tayoḥ*)—of them
- अन्यत् (*anyat*)—the day
- रोचते (*rocate*)—shines with light
- अन्यत् (*anyat*)—the night
- कृष्णं (*kṛṣṇaṃ*)—has assumed a black colour
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Day and night, in the form of a pair, have assumed manifold forms, white and black. The night and the day full of light are sisters of each other. Of them the day shines with light and the night wears a black colour. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

The twin pair (day and night) adopt various forms : one of them shines brightly, the other is black : twin sisters are they, one black and the other white : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

यम्या—मिथुनभूते (*yamyā—mithunabhūte*). This word is stated among the names of night (Ni. 2-18). श्यावी—कृष्णवर्णा (*śyāvī—kṛṣṇavarṇā*). This word too is read among the names of night (Ni. 2-18). In this Ṛk day and night are described. Of these, the day, through the spread of the sun's rays, is अरुषी—शुक्लवर्णा (*aruṣī—śuklavarṇā*), bright; the night, through its connection with darkness, is कृष्णं (*kṛṣṇaṃ*), black. Day and night परस्परं स्वसारौ भवतः (*parasparaṃ svasārau bhavataḥ*): because each follows the other, they are described as sisters. Yāska also—

(Yāska also, in the passage) अहश्च कृष्ण महरर्जुनं च विवर्तेते रजसी वेद्याभिः । (*ahaśca kṛṣṇa maharарjunaṃ ca vivartete rajasī vedyābhiḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-9-1), explains: अहश्च कृष्णं रात्रिः शुक्लं चाहरर्जुनं च विवर्तेते रजसी वेदितव्याभिः प्रवृत्तिभिः । (*ahaśca kṛṣṇaṃ rātri: śuklaṃ cāhararjunaṃ ca vivartete rajasī veditavyābhiḥ pravṛttibhiḥ* |) Day and night, these two, shine with the forms of white and black colour. Of these, the one that is white through its connection with the rays and bestows light on living beings is day. Night is black in colour and brings living beings rest from their activity. By their regular goings and comings (night passes, day comes; day passes, night comes), or by their effect, they are described as benefactors of living beings. The overwhelming might of the deities of day and night, who bear the forms of white and black as day and night and exist in manifold forms through their turnings, is beyond description.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मा॒ता च॒ यत्र॑ दुहि॒ता च॑ धे॒नू स॑ब॒र्दुघे॑ धा॒पये॑ते समी॒ची ।
ऋ॒तस्य॒ ते सद॑सीळे अ॒न्तर्म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ १२ ॥

> *mātā ca yatra duhitā ca dhenū sabardughe dhāpayete samīcī |*
> *ṛtasya te sadasīḷe antarmahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> माता । च । यत्र । दुहिता । च । धेनू इति । सबर्दुघे इति सबःदुघे । धापयेते
> इति । समीची इति सम्ईची ।
> ऋतस्य । ते इति । सदसि । ईळे । अंतः । महत् । देवानां । आसुरत्वं । एकं ॥ १२ ॥

> *mātā | ca | yatra | duhitā | ca | dhenū iti | sabardughe iti sabaḥdughe | dhāpayete*
> *iti | samīcī iti samīcī |*
> *ṛtasya | te iti | sadasi | īḷe | aṃtaḥ | mahat | devānāṃ | āsuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> माता सर्वेषां निर्मातृत्वान्माता पृथिवी च दुहिता दूरे निहिता द्यौश्च ।
> दुहिता दुर्हिता दूरे हिता दोग्देवेति यास्कः । एते सबर्दुघ्ने सबरः स्वीयस्य
> क्षीररूपस्य रसस्य दोग्धौ आत एव धेनू जगतः प्रीणयित्र्यौ द्यावापृथिव्यौ
> यत्रांतरिक्षे समीची परस्परं संगते सत्यौ धापयेते स्वकीयं रसमन्योन्यं
> पाययेते ऋतस्योदकस्य सदसि स्थानभूते तस्मिन्नंतरिक्षेंतः स्थिते द्यावापृथिव्या–

> *mātā sarveṣāṃ nirmātṛtvānmātā pṛthivī ca duhitā dūre nihitā dyauśca |*
> *duhitā durhitā dūre hitā dogdeveti yāskaḥ | ete sabardughne sabaraḥ svīyasya*
> *kṣīrarūpasya rasasya dògdhau āta eva dhenū jagataḥ prīṇayitryau dyāvāpṛthivyau*

> *yatrāṃtarikṣe samīcī parasparaṃ saṃgate satyau dhāpayete svakīyaṃ rasamanyonyaṃ*
> *pāyayete ṛtasyodakasya sadasi sthānabhūte tasminnaṃtarikṣeṃtaḥ sthite dyāvāpṛthivyā-*

> वीळे । अहं सौमि । यद्वा । वृष्टिलक्षणं रसं द्यौः पृथिवीं धापयत आहुतिलक्षणं
> रसं द्यां पृथिवीत्येवमन्योन्यं माता च दुहिता च भवतः । ऋतस्य सदसि स्थाने
> यज्ञसदने स्थितोऽहं ते उभे सौमि ॥ सबर्दुघे । सबःशब्दः क्षीरवाचीति संप्रदायविद आहुः ।
> तस्मिन्नुपपदे दुह प्रपूरण इत्यस्माद्धातोर्दुहः । कब्बश्चेति
> कप्पत्ययो घश्चांतादेशः । प्रत्ययस्य पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । धापयेते ।
> धेट् पान इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लटि निगरणचलनार्थेभ्यश्चेति परस्पैपदे प्राप्ते पादिसु
> धेट् उपसंख्यानमित्यात्मनेपदं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ॥

> *vīḷe | ahaṃ saumi | yadvā | vṛṣṭilakṣaṇaṃ rasaṃ dyauḥ pṛthivīṃ dhāpayata āhutilakṣaṇaṃ*
> *rasaṃ dyāṃ pṛthivītyevamanyonyaṃ mātā ca duhitā ca bhavataḥ | ṛtasya sadasi sthāne*
> *yajñasadane sthito 'haṃ te ubhe saumi ‖ sabardughe | sabaḥśabdaḥ kṣīravācīti saṃpradāyavida āhuḥ | tasminnupapade duha prapūraṇa ityasmāddātorduhaḥ | kabbaśceti*
> *kappatyayo ghaścāṃtādeśaḥ | pratyayasya pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | dhāpayete |*
> *dheṭ pāna ityasya ṇyaṃtasya laṭi nigaraṇacalanārthebhyaśceti paraspaipade prāpte pādisu*
> *dheṭ upasaṃkhyānamityātmanepadaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Mother": because she is the maker of all, the earth is the mother; "daughter" (duhitā) is Heaven, placed far away. Yāska: दुहिता दुर्हिता दूरे हिता दोग्देवेति (*duhitā durhitā dūre hitā dogdeveti*). These two are "sabardughe": sabar is their own sap in the form of milk, and they are the milkers of it; hence they are "dhenū", the two nourishers of the world, Heaven and Earth. In the firmament, where, meeting each other, they make each other drink their own sap, in the seat of ṛta, that is, of water — that firmament — I praise Heaven and Earth standing within it. (The block continues on the next page.)

(Continuing) "I praise." Or else: Heaven makes the earth drink the sap in the form of rain, and the earth makes Heaven drink the sap in the form of the oblation; so each is mother and daughter to the other. Standing at the seat of ṛta, the place of sacrifice, I praise both. "Sabardughe": those versed in tradition say that the word sabar denotes milk; the second member is formed from the root duh, "to fill".

Word-to-word meaning

- माता (*mātā*)—the earth, in the form of the mother
- दुहिता च (*duhitā ca*)—and also the firmament, placed far away[?117]
- सबर्दुघे (*sabardughe*)—milking together their sap in the form of milk
- धेनू (*dhenū*)—like milch cows that bring satisfaction to the world
- यत्र (*yatra*)—in which firmament
- समीची (*samīcī*)—meeting together
- धापयेते (*dhāpayete*)—exchanging their respective saps, they make each other drink
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of water
- सदसि (*sadasi*)—in the firmament, which is its seat
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—Heaven and Earth, standing within
- ईळे (*īḷe*)—I praise
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

The earth, in the form of the mother, and the far-placed firmament, milking together their sap in the form of milk, like milch cows that satisfy the world, meet together in the firmament and, exchanging their respective saps, make each other drink. In the firmament, the seat of water, I praise Heaven and Earth standing within it. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Where the mother and the daughter, two productive milch cows, unite, they nourish each other : I worship them both in (the firmament), the dwel- ling of the waters : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

माता—सर्वेषां निर्मातृत्वात् माता पृथिवी। (*mātā—sarveṣāṃ nirmātṛtvāt mātā pṛthivī*|) Because she brings forth everything, moving and unmoving, the earth is called the mother. दुहिता-दूरे नीता द्यौः च । (*duhitā-dūre nītā dyauḥ ca* |) Because the firmament is very far from the earth, it is designated duhitṛ (daughter).

Yāska has explained the meaning of the word duhitā as दुहिता, दूरेहिता, दोग्दीर्वा (*duhitā, dūrehitā, dogdīrvā*) (Ni. 3-4). Because, though far away and given to another in the proper manner, she wishes the welfare of her own people, the duhitā (daughter) is described as beneficial even though she may cause sorrow; and he explains that the word is derived from the root duh in the sense "to fill", that is, "to milk".

These Heaven and Earth: ऋतस्य सदसि समीची धापयेते—उदकस्य स्थानभूते तस्मिन् अंतरिक्षे परस्परं संगते सत्यौ स्वकीयां रसं अन्नोन्यं पाययेते । (*ṛtasya sadasi samīcī dhāpayete—udakasya sthānabhūte tasmin aṃtarikṣe parasparaṃ saṃgate satyau svakīyāṃ rasaṃ annonyaṃ pāyayete* |) In the firmament, where the waters gather, staying inseparable from one another, offering their respective saps to each other in exchange, they go on satisfying the worlds like cows that yield milk. One kind of meaning has been described thus.

यद्वा वृष्टिलक्षणं रसं दौः पृथिवीं धापयते । आहुतिलक्षणं रसं द्यां पृथिवीति एवं माता दुहिता च भवतः । (*yadvā vṛṣṭilakṣaṇaṃ rasaṃ dauḥ pṛthivīṃ dhāpayate | āhutilakṣaṇaṃ rasaṃ dyāṃ pṛthivīti evaṃ mātā duhitā ca bhavataḥ* |) In the first meaning, motherhood of Heaven and Earth is established with regard to the world through their doing good to it, and daughterhood through their satisfying the world with their saps. In the second meaning, since the earth makes Heaven drink the sap in the form of the oblation and Heaven makes the earth drink the sap in the form of rain, there arises between the two a motherhood in the sense of mutual nourishing, and a daughterhood through the milking of the sap; this is what is described as the second meaning.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒न्यस्या॑ व॒त्सं रि॑ह॒ती मि॑माय॒ कया॑ भु॒वा नि द॑धे धे॒नुरूध॑ः ।
ऋ॒तस्य॒ सा पय॑सापिन्व॒तेळा॑ म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसुर॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ १३ ॥

> *anyasyā vatsaṃ rihatī mimāya kayā bhuvā ni dadhe dhenurūdhaḥ |*
> *ṛtasya sā payasāpinvateḷā mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अन्यस्याः । वत्सं । रिहती । मिमाय । कया । भुवा । नि । दधे । धेनुः । ऊधः ।
> ऋतस्य । सा । पयसा । अपिन्वत । इळा । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥१३॥

> *anyasyāḥ | vatsaṃ | rihatī | mimāya | kayā | bhuvā | ni | dadhe | dhenuḥ | ūdhaḥ |*
> *ṛtasya | sā | payasā | apinvata | iḷā | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖13‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अन्यस्याः पृथिव्या वत्समग्निं रिहत्युदकधारारूपया जिह्वया लिहती द्यौर्मिमाय । मेघद्वारा ध्वनिं करोति । धेनुः प्रीणयित्री सा द्यौः कया जलवर्जितया

> *anyasyāḥ pṛthivyā vatsamagniṃ rihatyudakadhārārūpayā jihvayā lihatī dyaurmimāya | meghadvārā dhvaniṃ karoti | dhenuḥ prīṇayitrī sā dyauḥ kayā jalavarjitayā*

> भुवा तत्रत्यं जलमादाय स्वकीयमूधो मेघरूपं नि दधे । उदकेन निहितमकरोत् । सा
> जलवर्जितेळा पृथिव्यृतस्य सत्यभूतस्यादित्यस्य पयसोदकेनापिन्वत ।
> वर्षकाले सिक्ता भवति । आदित्याज्जायते वृष्टिः । मनु. ३–७६ । इति स्मृतेः ॥ रिहती ।
> लिह आस्वादन इत्यस्य शतरि रूपं । शतुरनुम इति जीप उदात्तत्वं । अपिन्वत । पिवि
> सेचने । मुचादिरात्मनेपदी । निघातः ॥

> *bhuvā tatratyaṃ jalamādāya svakīyamūdho megharūpaṃ ni dadhe |*
> *udakena nihitamakarot | sā jalavarjiteḷā pṛthivyṛtasya*
> *satyabhūtasyādityasya payasodakenāpinvata |*
> *varṣakāle siktā bhavati | ādityājjāyate vṛṣṭiḥ | manu. 3-76 | iti smṛteḥ ‖*
> *rihatī |*
> *liha āsvādana ityasya śatari rūpaṃ | śaturanuma iti jīpa udāttatvaṃ |*
> *apinvata | pivi*
> *secane | mucādirātmanepadī | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Of the other", that is, of the earth, Heaven licks the calf, Agni, with a tongue in the form of streams of water, and lows: through the cloud she makes a sound. "Dhenu" is the nourishing Heaven; "kayā": with the waterless (earth)...

(Continuing) ...taking the water from there, she places her own udder, in the form of cloud; she makes it stored with water. That waterless Iḷā, the earth, is swelled by the water of Āditya, who is the truth (ṛta); she is sprinkled in the rainy season. For the smṛti says आदित्याज्जायते वृष्टिः (*ādityājjāyate vṛṣṭiḥ*) (Manu. 3-76).[?118]

Word-to-word meaning

- अन्यस्या: (*anyasyā:*)—of the earth, one of the two worlds
- वत्सं (*vatsaṃ*)—the calf-like Agni
- रिहती (*rihatī*)—licking with a tongue in the form of streams
- मिमाय (*mimāya*)—(through the cloud) the presiding deity of the world of heaven makes a sound
- धेनुः (*dhenuḥ*)—Heaven, the bringer of pleasure
- कया (*kayā*)—waterless
- भुवा (*bhuvā*)—from the earth (drawing the water)
- ऊधः (*ūdhaḥ*)—her udder in the form of cloud

- नि दधे (*ni dadhe*)—she places
- सा (*sā*)—that
- इळा (*iḷā*)—the earth, being waterless
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of Āditya, who is of the nature of truth
- पयसा (*payasā*)—with the water
- अपिन्वत (*apinvata*)—is drenched
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Licking, with a tongue in the form of streams, Agni, the calf-like son of the earth, one of the two worlds, the presiding deity of the world of heaven makes a sound through the cloud. The nourishing world of heaven, drawing water from the waterless earth, gives her udder, in the form of cloud, to the earth. That waterless earth is drenched by the water of Āditya, who is of the nature of truth. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.[?119]

English translation

Licking the calf of the other, one of them lows aloud : the milch cow offers her udder for the one that is without moisture (the earth), and she (the earth) is refreshed by the milk of the rain : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

धेनुः—प्रीणयित्री सा द्यौः । (*dhenuḥ—prīṇayitrī sā dyauḥ |*) The word dhenu is stated among the words for speech (Ni. 2-23). The meaning is explained thus: the world of heaven is the dhenu (cow), and it satisfies. In this Ṛk, in a poetic style, the world of heaven is called a cow, and the nature of a cow toward her calf is described. Moreover, it is not natural for one cow to nourish the calf of another.

Here: पृथिव्याः वत्समग्निं उदकधारारूपया जिह्वया लिहती द्यौ: मेघद्वारा ध्वनिं करोति । (*pṛthivyāḥ vatsamagniṃ udakadhārārūpayā jihvayā lihatī dyau: meghadvārā dhvaniṃ karoti |*) The world of heaven satisfies with streams of water

Agni, who is like the son of the earth or is her son (as a cow licks her calf with love), and, as a cow makes the sound that calls her calf near, makes the sound of the clouds. By this the thunder of the clouds is presented as the calf-calling sound of the cow.

Of the world of heaven, भुवा ऊधः निदधे—तत्रत्यं जलवादाय स्वकीयं मेघरूपं ऊधः उदकेन निहितमकरोत् । (*bhuvā ūdhaḥ nidadhe—tatratyaṃ jalavādāya svakīyaṃ megharūpaṃ ūdhaḥ udakena nihitamakarot* |) Gathering the waters that are on the earth, she makes her udder, which is in the form of cloud, full of sap. Afterwards, when the rainy season arrives, इळा ऋतस्य पयसा अपिन्वत (*iḷā ṛtasya payasā apinvata*): the earth is drenched with waters from the side of Āditya, who is of the nature of truth. Having explained the meaning thus, he cites the Manu-smṛti text आदित्याज्ञायते वृष्टिः वृष्टेरन्नं ततः प्रजाः (*ādityājñāyate vṛṣṭiḥ vṛṣṭerannaṃ tataḥ prajāḥ*) (Manu. 3-17): from Āditya comes rain, from rain food, and from food the creatures.?120 Thus, because Heaven and Earth are engaged in the origin and so on of the worlds, the might of the gods is explained as unequalled.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पद्या॑ वस्ते पुरु॒रूपा॒ वपूं॑ष्यू॒र्ध्वा त॑स्थौ॒ त्र्यवि॒ं रेरिं॑हाणा ।
ऋ॒तस्य॒ सद्म॒ वि चं॑रामि वि॒द्वान्म॒हद्दे॒वानां॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेकं॑म् ॥ १४ ॥

> *padyā vaste pururūpā vapūṃṣyūrdhvā tasthau tryaviṃ rerihāṇā* |
> *ṛtasya sadma vi carāmi vidvānmahaddevānāmasuratvamekam* ‖ *14* ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> पद्या । वस्ते । पुरुरूपा । वपूंषि । ऊर्ध्वा । तस्थौ । त्रिअपिं । रेरिहाणा ।
> यतस्य । सद्म । वि । चरामि । विद्वान् । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ १४ ॥

> *padyā | vaste | pururūpā | vapūṃṣi | ūrdhvā | tasthau | triapiṃ | rerihāṇā |*
> *yatasya | sadma | vi | carāmi | vidvān | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पद्या । जगत्प्रष्टुः परमेश्वरस्य पद्भां जातत्वात्पद्या भूमिः । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । पद्भां भूमिः । ऋग्वे. १०–९० १४ । इति । यद्वा । पादसंचारे साधुः
> पद्या भूमिः पुरुरूपा नानाविधस्वरूपाणि वपूंषि स्थावरजंगमात्मकानि रूपाणि
> वस्ते । आच्छादयति । सैषा भूमिरूर्ध्वोत्तरवेद्यात्मनोन्नता सती स्वसारभूतेन
> हविषा त्रैविं । सार्धसंवत्सरवयस्को वत्सस्त्रविरित्युच्यते । तत्प्रमाणमादित्यं ।

> *padyā | jagatpraṣṭuḥ parameśvarasya padbhāṃ jātatvātpadyā bhūmiḥ | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | padbhāṃ bhūmiḥ | ṛgve. 10-90 14 | iti | yadvā | pādasaṃcāre sādhuḥ*
> *padyā bhūmiḥ pururūpā nānāvidhasvarūpāṇi vapūṃṣi sthāvarajaṃgamātmakāni rūpāṇi*
> *vaste | ācchādayati | saiṣā bhūmirūrdhvottaravedyātmanonnatā satī svasārabhūtena*
> *haviṣā traiviṃ | sārdhasaṃvatsaravayasko vatsastravirityucyate | tatpramāṇamādityaṃ |*

> श्रीन् लोकानवति स्वतेजसा व्याप्पोतीति त्र्यविरिति वा । रेरिहाणा लिहती तस्थौ ।
> ऋतस्य सत्यभूतस्यादित्यस्य सद्म स्थानं विद्वान् जानानोऽहं वि चरामि । हविर्भिस्तमादित्यं परिचरामि ॥ पद्या । पादशब्दाव्यवे छंदसीति यत् । पद्यत्यतदर्थे । पा–
> ६–३–५३ । इति पादस्य पद्भावः । यद्वा । तत्र साधुरिति यत् । यतोऽनाथ इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं । त्र्यविं । अव रक्षणादिसु । इन्नितीन्प्रत्ययः । कृत्सरः । रेरिहाणा । लिह
> आस्वादन इत्यस्य यज्लुकि शानचि रूपं । अभ्यस्तस्वरः ॥

> *śrīn lokānavati svatejasā vyāppotīti tryaviriti vā | rerihāṇā lihatī tasthau |*
> *ṛtasya satyabhūtasyādityasya sadma sthānaṃ vidvān jānāno 'haṃ vi carāmi | havirbhistamādityaṃ paricarāmi ‖ padyā | pādaśabdāvyave chaṃdasīti yat | padyatyatadarthe | pā-*
> *6-3-53 | iti pādasya padbhāvaḥ | yadvā | tatra sādhuriti yat | yato 'nātha ityādyudāttatvaṃ | tryaviṃ | ava rakṣaṇādisu | innitīnpratyayaḥ | kṛtsaraḥ | rerihāṇā | liha*
> *āsvādana ityasya yajluki śānaci rūpaṃ | abhyastasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"Padyā": the earth is padyā because she was born from the feet (pad) of the Lord, the creator of the world. So the mantra says पद्भां भूमिः (*padbhāṃ bhūmiḥ*) (Ṛg. 10-90-14). Or else: the earth is padyā as being good for movement on foot. Padyā, the earth, wears (vaste) manifold bodies, forms of the nature of the unmoving and the moving; that is, she covers them. This earth, standing high as the northern altar, with the oblation that is her own essence[?121], (licks) the "trayavi": a calf of one and a half years is called travi; Āditya is of that measure.

(Continuing) Or "trayavi" because he protects the three worlds, pervading them with his own splendour. Licking (rerihāṇā), she stands. Knowing the seat, the abode, of ṛta, that is, of Āditya who is truth, I move about: I serve that Āditya with oblations.

Word-to-word meaning

- पद्मा (*padmā*)—the earth[?122]
- पुरुरूपा (*pururūpā*)—of manifold forms
- वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)—forms of the nature of the unmoving and the moving
- वस्ते (*vaste*)—she wears
- ऊर्ध्वा (*ūrdhvā*)—from a high place in the form of the northern altar
- त्रैविं (*traiviṃ*)—Āditya, who is like a son of one and a half years[?123]
- रेरिहाणा (*rerihāṇā*)—licking by means of the oblation
- तस्थौ (*tasthau*)—she stands
- यतस्य (*yatasya*)—of Āditya, who is of the nature of truth[?124]
- सद्म (*sadma*)—the abode
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—I who know
- वि चरामि (*vi carāmi*)—I worship him
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and without a second

Gist

The earth wears forms of many kinds, of the nature of the unmoving and the moving. From a high place in the form of the northern altar she stands licking, by means of the oblation, Āditya, who is like a son of one and a half years. I, who know the abode of Āditya, who is of the nature of truth, worship him with oblations. The might of the gods is great and without a second.

English translation

The earth wears bodies of many forms : she abides on high cherishing her year and a half old (calf) : knowing the abode of the truth (the sun), I offer worship : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the earth, जगत्प्रष्टुः परमेश्वरस्य पद्भ्यां जातत्वात् (*jagatpraṣṭuḥ parameśvarasya padbhyāṃ jātatvāt*), since she was born from the feet of the Supreme Lord who made the whole universe, is designated by the word padyā. On this point the mantra is also cited: पद्भ्यां भूमि (*padbhyāṃ bhūmi*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-90-14). Or else, पादसंचारे साधुः (*pādasaṃcāre sādhuḥ*): because she has made for all living beings a way fit for moving about on their own feet, the word padyā is used in the sense of the earth.

For the things born of her, this earth, पुरुरूपा वपूंषि वस्ते (*pururūpā vapūṃṣi vaste*), makes bodies furnished with manifold forms, fixed or moving, and covers their true nature.

त्रैविं—सार्थसंवत्सरवयस्कः वत्सः (*traiviṃ—sārthasaṃvatsaravayaskaḥ vatsaḥ*): the meaning is given as a calf one and a half years old. Or त्री लोकान् अवति स्वतेजसा व्याप्नोति (*trī lokān avati svatejasā vyāpnnoti*): he is explained as the one who pervades and protects the three worlds with his splendour.

ऊर्ध्वा—उत्तरवेदात्मना उन्नता । (*ūrdhvā—uttaravedātmanā unnatā |*) This earth is described as standing high in the sacrificial hall in the form of the northern altar, and as satisfying, with the oblations (by the offering of the oblation), Āditya, denoted by the word travi, who is of the measure of a calf of one and a half years.

The sacrificer, who knows the true nature of this Āditya and the dwelling-place where he abides, offers oblations to Āditya; and the might of the gods is described as unequalled and full of greatness.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प॒दे इ॑व॒ निहि॑ते द॒स्मे अ॒न्तस्तयो॑र॒न्यद्गुह्य॑मा॒विर॒न्यत् ।

स॒ध्री॒ची॒ना प॒थ्या॒३॒॑ सा विषू॑ची म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ १५ ॥

> *pade iva nihite dasme antastayoranyadguhyamāviranyat |*
> *sadhrīcīnā pathyā sā viṣūcī mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पदे इवेति पदेऽइव । निहिते इति निहिते । दस्मे । अंतरिति । तयोः। अन्यत् । गुह्यं।
> आविः । अन्यत् ।
> सध्रीचीना। पथ्या । सा । विषूची । महत् । देवनां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ ८५ ॥

> *pade iveti pade 'iva | nihite iti nihite | dasme | aṃtariti | tayoḥ| anyat | guhyaṃ|*
> *āviḥ | anyat |*
> *sadhrīcīnā| pathyā | sā | viṣūcī | mahat | devanāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 85 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पदे इव । पद्येते ज्ञायेते तत्तदसाधारणलिंगेनेति पदे । अहश्च रात्रिश्चेत्येते दस्मे सर्वैर्दर्शनीये ते उभे अंतर्नभसि मध्ये निहिते स्थापिते इव
> वर्तेते । तयोरहोरात्रयोरन्यद्रात्रिलक्षणं गुह्यमप्रकाशमानतेया गूढमि–

> *pade iva | padyete jñāyete tattadasādhāraṇaliṃgeneti pade | ahaśca rātriścetyete dasme sarvairdarśanīye te ubhe aṃtarnabhasi madhye nihite sthāpite iva*
> *vartete | tayorahorātrayoranyadrātrilakṣaṇaṃ guhyamaprakāśamānatèyā gūḍhami-*

> वास्ते । अन्यदहराविः सूर्यप्रकाशेन प्रकटं भवति । सध्रीचीनाहोरात्रयोः
> परस्परमेलनरूपा पथ्या मार्गः । काल इत्यर्थः । सा विषूची । पुण्यकृतोऽपुण्यकृतश्च
> प्राप्नोतीति विषूची भवति । सर्वे जना अहोरात्रयोर्वर्तंते । यद्वा ।
> पदे इव देवमनुष्यादीनां स्थानभूते द्यावापृथिव्यावंतरंतरिक्षे निहिते वर्तेते ।
> तयोरन्यद्द्यौर्गुह्यमस्माभिरदृश्यमानतया गूढं वर्तते । अन्यत्पृथिव्याविः सर्वैर्दृश्यमानत्वेन
> प्रकटा भवति । सध्रीचीनेति पूर्ववत् ॥ सध्रीचीना । सहपूर्वादंचतेः क्विन् । सहस्य सध्रिरिति
> सध्र्या देशः । विभाषांचेरदिक्स्त्रियामिति खः ॥

> *vāste | anyadaharāviḥ sūryaprakāśena prakaṭaṃ bhavati | sadhrīcīnāhorātrayoḥ*
> *parasparamelanarūpā pathyā mārgaḥ | kāla ityarthaḥ | sā viṣūcī | puṇyakṛto 'puṇyakṛtaśca prāpnotīti viṣūcī bhavati | sarve janā ahorātrayorvartaṃte | yadvā |*
> *pade iva devamanuṣyādīnāṃ sthānabhūte dyāvāpṛthivyāvaṃtaraṃtarikṣe nihite vartete |*
> *tayoranyaddaurguhyamasmābhiradṛśyamānatayā gūḍhaṃ vartate | anyatpṛthivyāviḥ sarvairdṛśyamānatvena prakaṭā bhavati | sadhrīcīneti pūrvavat ‖ sadhrīcīnā | sahapūrvādaṃcateḥ kvin | sahasya sadhririti sadhryā deśaḥ | vibhāṣāṃceradikstriyāmiti khaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Padye iva": the two are known (padyete) by their respective distinctive marks, hence "pade". Day and night, these two, "dasme", visible to all, stand, as it were, placed (nihite) within the sky, in the middle. Of the two, day and night, the other, that of the nature of night, is "guhya": hidden, because it does not shine… (the block breaks off here).

Sāyaṇa continues his explanation of the preceding verse. The other of the two, the day, becomes manifest through the light of the sun. सध्रीचीना (*sadhrīcīnā*) is the path (पथ्या (*pathyā*)) formed by the day and night meeting each other, that is, time. That path is विषूची (*viṣūcī*): it reaches the doers of merit and the doers of demerit alike. All people live within day and night.

Alternatively, the two पदे इव (*pade iva*) are heaven and earth, the abodes of gods, men and others, which lie placed within the atmosphere. Of these two, one is hidden because we cannot see it; the other, the earth, is manifest because it is seen by all. सध्रीचीना (*sadhrīcīnā*) and the rest are as before.

(The rest of the block is grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- दस्मे (*dasme*)—visible to all
- पदे इव (*pade iva*)—the day and the night, both
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the midst of the atmosphere
- निहिते (*nihite*)—are placed
- तयोः (*tayoḥ*)—of those two
- अन्यत् (*anyat*)—the night
- गुह्यं (*guhyaṃ*)—is hidden
- अन्यत् (*anyat*)—the other one, the day
- आविः (*āviḥ*)—is manifest
- सध्रीचीना (*sadhrīcīnā*)—joined together with both of these
- सा पथ्या (*sā pathyā*)—the path in the form of time
- विसूची (*visūcī*)—is common to the whole universe
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Day and night, both visible to all, are placed in the middle region of the atmosphere. Of the two, the night is hidden and the day is manifest. The path in the form of time, which is joined to both of them together, is common to the whole universe. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Like two (distinguishing) impressions, they (day and night) are placed visible in the midst (between heaven and earth), one hidden, one manifest : the path (of both) is common, and that is universal (for good and evil): great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

अहश्च रात्रिश्चेत्येते सर्वैः दर्शनीये तत्तदसाधारणलिंगेन ज्ञायमाने नभसि मध्ये स्थापिते इव वर्तेते । (*ahaśca rātriścetyete sarvaiḥ darśanīye tattadasādhāraṇaliṃgena jñāyamāne nabhasi madhyè sthāpite iva vartete* |). The qualities that belong to day and to night, and their respective marks, are known by everyone as distinguishing them from each other. Since these day-and-nights are endowed with a charming form, they appear as if placed within the atmosphere. They are described as follows: the path that is favourable to both is time; this time is विषूची (*viṣūcī*), that is, पुण्यकृतो अपुण्यकृतश्च प्राप्नोति (*puṇyakṛto apuṇyakṛtaśca prāpnoti*), it pervades all, the virtuous and the sinful alike; and सर्वे जना अहोरात्रयोर्वर्तंते (*sarve janā ahorātrayorvartaṃte*), it provides all living beings with room to live.

The second meaning concerns heaven and earth. यद्वा पदे इव देवमनुष्यादीनां स्थानभूते द्यावापृथिव्य अंतरंतरिक्षे निहिते वर्तते । तयोरन्यत् अन्या द्यौः गुह्यमस्माभिः अदृश्यमानतेया गूढा वर्तते । अन्या पृथिवी आविः सर्वैः दृश्यमानतेन प्रकटा भवति । (*yadvā pade iva devamanuṣyādīnāṃ sthānabhūte dyāvāpṛthivya aṃtaraṃtarikṣe nihite vartate | tayoranyat anyā dyauḥ guhyamasmābhiḥ adṛśyamānatèyā gūḍhā vartate | anyā pṛthivī āviḥ sarvaiḥ dṛśyamānatena prakaṭā bhavati* |). सध्रीचीनेत्यादि पूर्ववत् (*sadhrīcīnetyādi pūrvavat*). Heaven and earth, which are like dwelling places of gods and men, lie in the atmosphere. Of these, the world of heaven is hidden in a way unknown to us, so that it cannot be seen by us, just as the night is hidden among day and night. The earth is manifest in a form that is known to all, as the day is bright with the light of the sun. Since the time that corresponds to the mutual adherence of these two is the same for the virtuous and the sinful, it is uneven. Because heaven and earth give room to all beings to live, they are benefactors of all; and the might of the gods is described as extraordinary and pre-eminent.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ धे॒नवो॑ धुनयन्ता॒मशि॑श्वीः सब॒र्दुघा॑ः शश॒या अप्र॑दुग्धाः ।
नव्या॑नव्या युव॒तयो॒ भव॑न्तीर्म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ १६ ॥

> *ā dhenavo dhunayantāmaśiśvīḥ sabardughāḥ śaśayā apradugdhāḥ |*
> *navyānavyā yuvatayo bhavantīrmahaddevānāmasuratvamekam* || *16* ||

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । धेनवः । धुनयंतां । अशिश्वीः । सबर्दुघाः । शशयाः । अप्रदुग्धाः ।
> नव्याःनव्याः । युवतयः । भवंतीः । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ १६ ॥

> *ā* | *dhenavaḥ* | *dhunayaṃtām* | *aśiśvīḥ* | *sabardughāḥ* | *śaśayāḥ* | *apradugdhāḥ* |
> *navyāḥnavyāḥ* | *yuvatayaḥ* | *bhavaṃtīḥ* | *mahat* | *devānāṃ* | *asuratvaṃ* | *ekaṃ* || *16* ||

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> धेनवो वृष्टिद्वारा सर्वस्य जगतः प्रीणयित्र्योऽशिश्वीः शिशुरहिताः । यद्वा ।
> शिकवो न भवंतीत्यशिश्वीः । शशया नभसि शयाना वर्तमानाः केनाप्यप्रमग्ता अक्षीण–

> *dhenavo vṛṣṭidvārā sarvasya jagataḥ prīṇayitryo 'śiśvīḥ śiśurahitāḥ |*
> *yadvā |*
> *śikavo na bhavaṃtītyaśiśvīḥ | śaśayā nabhasi śayānā vartamānāḥ*
> *kenāpyapramagtā akṣīṇa-*

> रसाः सबर्दुघा उदकलक्षणस्य क्षीरस्य दोग्धो युवतयः परस्परमिश्रणोपेता
> नव्या नव्या अतिशयेन नूतना भवंतीर्दिशो मेघा ना आ धुनयंतां । आदुहंतु ।
> मेघपक्षेशिश्वीर्भवंतीत्यत्र लिंगव्यत्ययः ॥ धुनयंतां । धूञ् कंपने । णिचि
> धूञ् प्रीणोर्नुग्वक्तव्यः । पा– ७–३–३७–१ । इति नुक् । ह्रस्वश्चांदसः । अशिश्वीं ।
> सख्यशिश्वीति भाषायामिति व्यत्ययेन छंदसि भवति ॥

> *rasāḥ sabardughā udakalakṣaṇasya kṣīrasya dogdho yuvatayaḥ*
> *parasparamiśraṇopetā*
> *navyā navyā atiśayena nūtanā bhavaṃtīrdiśo meghā nā ā dhunayaṃtāṃ*
> *| āduhaṃtu |*
> *meghapakṣeśiśvīrbhavaṃtītyatra liṃgavyatyayaḥ ‖ dhunayaṃtāṃ |*
> *dhūñ kaṃpane | ṇici*
> *dhūñ prīṇornugvaktavyaḥ | pā- 7-3-37-1 | iti nuk | hrasvaścāṃdasaḥ |*
> *aśiśvīṃ | sakhyaśiśvīti bhāṣāyāmiti vyatyayena chaṃdasi bhavati ‖*

Summary

The धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*) are the cows that gratify the whole world by means of rain. अशिश्वीः (*aśiśvīḥ*) means "without young"; or else, शिकवो न भवंतीत्यशिश्वीः (*śikavo na bhavaṃtītyaśiśvīḥ*), "they are not infants". शशयाः (*śaśayāḥ*) are those lying in the sky, unharmed by anyone and undiminished in sap (the sentence continues on the next page).

सबर्दुघाः (*sabardughāḥ*) are those that yield the milk that has the form of water. युवतयः (*yuvatayaḥ*) are those endowed with mutual mixing. The quarters, or the clouds, becoming exceedingly new, नव्या नव्या (*navyā navyā*), are to be shaken, आ धुनयंतां (*ā dhunayaṃtāṃ*), that is, आदुहंतु (*āduhaṃtu*), "let them milk out". In the case of the clouds, in "aśiśvīr bhavanti" there is an exchange of gender. (The rest of the block is grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*)—the cows that gratify the world
- अशिश्वीः (*aśiśvīḥ*)—those without young

- शशयाः (*śaśayāḥ*)—those that remain fixed in the atmosphere
- अप्रदुग्धाः (*apradugdhāḥ*)—those full of sap
- सबर्दुघाः (*sabardughāḥ*)—those that pour out the milk that has the form of water
- युवतयः (*yuvatayaḥ*)—those that are mutually joined
- नव्यानव्याः (*navyānavyāḥ*)—those that always attain newness
- भवंतीः (*bhavaṃtīḥ*)—being so, the clouds (or the quarters)
- आ धुनयंतां (*ā dhunayaṃtāṃ*)—let them be shaken (for the sake of each one)
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Let the clouds, which gratify the world, are without young, abide fixed in the atmosphere, are full of sap, pour out the milk that has the form of water, are mutually joined and always attain newness, be shaken, each for its own purpose. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

May the milch cows without their young, abiding (in the heaven), and though unmilked, yet yielding milk, and ever fresh and youthful, be shaken (so as to perform their functions) : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

The Anukramaṇikā says that this sixteenth mantra of the sūkta has the quarters (दिग्वचनते (*digvacanatè*)) as its deity. In the bhāṣya Sāyaṇa explains the meaning thus: दिशः मेघा वा आ धुनयंतां आ दुहंतु (*diśaḥ meghā vā ā dhunayaṃtāṃ ā duhaṃtu*), "let the quarters or the clouds keep us in joy". Neither a word for the quarters nor a word for the clouds is used here separately; only the epithets are common to both kinds of meaning, clouds or quarters. The clouds gratify the world by pouring rain. "Aśiśvī" means being without sons, or not having children; शशयाः (*śaśayāḥ*) means remaining in the atmosphere itself;

अप्रदुग्दाः (*apradugdāḥ*) means being filled with water; सबर्दुघाः (*sabardughāḥ*) means milking the milk that has the form of water; युवतयः (*yuvatayaḥ*) means being joined together mutually; नव्यानव्याः (*navyānavyāḥ*) means being in an ever-new manner. Since all these qualities belong to the quarters as well, the prayer of the sacrificer is stated: let these clouds, or these quarters, keep us, the sacrificers, in joy.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यद॒न्यासु॑ वृष॒भो रोर॑वीति॒ सो अ॒न्यस्मि॑न्यू॒थे नि द॑धाति॒ रेत॑ः ।
स हि क्षपा॑वा॒न्स भग॒ः स राजा॑ म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसुर॒त्वमेक॑म् ॥ १७ ॥

> *yadanyāsu vṛṣabho roravīti so anyasminyūthe ni dadhāti retaḥ |*
> *sa hi kṣapāvānsa bhagaḥ sa rājā mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यत् । अन्यासु । वृषभः । रोरवीति । सः । अन्यस्मिन् । यूथे । नि । दधाति । रेतः ।
> सः । हि । क्षपावान् । सः । भगः । सः । राजा । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं॥
> ॥ १७ ॥

> *yat | anyāsu | vṛṣabhaḥ | roravīti | saḥ | anyasmin | yūthe | ni | dadhāti | retaḥ |*
> *saḥ | hi | kṣapāvān | saḥ | bhagaḥ | saḥ | rājā | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ‖*
> *‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषभोऽपां वर्षको यद्यः पर्जन्यात्मेंद्रोऽन्यासु दिक्षु रोरवीति
> मेघद्वारा भृशं शब्दं करोति स पर्जन्य इंद्रोऽन्यस्मिन्यूथे दिशां वृंदे रेत
> उदकं नि दधाति । तत्र वर्षति । लोके हि वृषभः कासुचिद्वोषु रेतःसेकार्थं रवं
> करोत्यन्यस्मिन् गोयूथे रेतः सिंचति । तद्वत् । स इंद्रः क्षपावान् । क्षिपति शत्रूनुदकं वेति
> क्षेपणवान् । यद्वा । क्षपा रात्रिः । तथा रात्रि पर्यायियागानां स्तोत्राणां भागभूता या रात्रिः
> सोच्यते । तद्वान् । स भगः । सर्वैर्भजनीयः । स
> राजा हि । तत्तत्कर्मानुरूपफलप्रदानेन सर्वेषां राजा खलु ॥ रोरवीति । रु शब्द
> इत्यस्य यज् लुगंतस्य लटि रूपं । एकान्याभ्यां समर्थाभ्यामिति प्रथमस्य न निघातः।
> यूथे । यु मिश्रणे । तिथपृष्ट गूथयूथप्रोथा इति थक्प्रत्ययांतत्वेन निपातनाद्दीर्घः । रेतः । रीज्
> क्षरण इत्यस्मात् सुरीभ्यां तुट् चेत्यसुन्नत्ययस्तुडागमश्च । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *vṛṣabho 'pāṃ varṣako yadyaḥ parjanyātmeṃdro 'nyāsu dikṣu roravīti*
> *meghadvārā bhṛśaṃ śabdaṃ karoti sa parjanya iṃdro 'nyasminyūthe diśāṃ vṛṃde reta*
> *udakaṃ ni dadhāti | tatra varṣati | loke hi vṛṣabhaḥ kāsuciddoṣu retaḥsekārthaṃ ravaṃ*
> *karotyanyasmin goyūthe retaḥ siṃcati | tadvat | sa iṃdraḥ kṣapāvān | kṣipati śatrūnudakaṃ veti kṣepaṇavān | yadvā | kṣapā rātriḥ | tathā rātri paryāyayāgānāṃ stotrāṇāṃ bhāgabhūtā yā rātriḥ socyate | tadvān | sa bhagaḥ | sarvairbhajanīyaḥ | sa*
> *rājā hi | tattatkarmānurūpaphalapradānena sarveṣāṃ rājā khalu ‖ roravīti | ru śabda*
> *ityasya yaj lugaṃtasya laṭi rūpaṃ | ekānyābhyāṃ samarthābhyāmiti prathamasya na nighātaḥ|*
> *yūthe | yu miśraṇe | tithapṛṣṭa gūthayūthaprothā iti thakpratyayāṃtatvena nipātanāddīrghaḥ | retaḥ | rīj kṣaraṇa ityasmāt surībhyāṃ tuṭ cetyasunnatyayastuḍāgamaśca | nittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

The bull, the rainer of waters, is Indra in the form of Parjanya. When he roars loudly among the other quarters by means of the clouds, that same Parjanya-Indra deposits रेतः (*retaḥ*), water, in another herd, the multitude of the quarters; there it rains. In the world a bull makes a roar over certain cows in order to shed seed, and sheds seed in another herd of cows; it is like that. That Indra is क्षपावान् (*kṣapāvān*): क्षिपति शत्रूनुदकं वेति (*kṣipati śatrūnudakaṃ veti*), he throws enemies or water, so he is possessed of throwing. Or else क्षपा (*kṣapā*) is night: the night that forms a part of the hymns of the rātri-paryāya sacrifices is called so, and he possesses it. He is भगः (*bhagaḥ*), to be worshipped by all. He is the king, for by granting fruit in accordance with each deed he is king of all. (The rest of the block is grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—the water-pourer
- यत् (*yat*)—the Indra, of the nature of Parjanya, who
- अन्यासु (*anyāsu*)—in the other quarters
- गोरवीति (*goravīti*)—makes a sound by means of the cloud?[126]
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same Indra of the nature of Parjanya
- अन्यस्मिन् यूथे (*anyasmin yūthe*)—in another quarter
- रेतः (*retaḥ*)—the water in the form of rain
- नि दधाति (*ni dadhāti*)—pours down
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same Indra
- क्षपावान् (*kṣapāvān*)—possessed of night
- सः (*saḥ*)—he
- भगः (*bhagaḥ*)—venerable
- सः (*saḥ*)—he
- राजा हि (*rājā hi*)—is also the lord
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unequalled

Gist

Indra, the maker of rain and of the nature of Parjanya, makes the sound of thunder in one quarter by means of the cloud and pours down rain in another quarter. Indra is possessed of night, venerable and the lord. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

When the showerer roars in other (regions) he sends down the rain upon a different herd, for he is the victor, the asuspicious, the sovereign : great and unequalled is the might of the gods,

Special Topics

The word रेतः (*retaḥ*) is listed among the names of water (Ni. 2-24). Indra, who is in the form of Parjanya, is described as being in the form of a bull. वृषभः अपां वर्षकं अन्यासु दिक्षु मेघद्वारा भृशं शब्दं करोति अन्यस्मि यूथे दितां वृंदे उदकं वर्षति । लोकेहि वृषभः कासुचित् गोषु रेतस्सेकार्थं रवं करोति अन्यस्मिन् गोयूथे रेतस्सिंचति तद्वत् । (*vṛṣabhaḥ apāṃ varṣakaṃ anyāsu dikṣu meghadvārā bhṛśaṃ śabdaṃ karoti anyasmi yūthe ditāṃ vṛṃde udakaṃ varṣati | loke hi vṛṣabhaḥ kāsucit goṣu retassekārthaṃ ravaṃ karoti anyasmin goyūthe retassiṃcati tadvat* |)[?127]. In the world a bull, while bellowing in a herd of cows, unites with a cow in another herd. In the same way Indra, making a sound through the clouds in order to pour rain in one quarter, pours water in the form of rain in another quarter; thus the likeness to a bull is established for Indra.

Two kinds of meaning are set out for the word क्षपावान् (*kṣapāvān*)[?128]. For the word क्षपा (*kṣapā*) the meaning "throwing, hurling" (क्षेपण (*kṣepaṇa*)) is given. From this it is explained that Indra is one who drives away enemies, or one who pours waters down for the worlds.

The word क्षपा (*kṣapā*) is listed among the names of night (Ni. 2-18). Sāyaṇa says क्षपा रात्रिः । रात्रि पर्यायियागानां स्तोत्राणां भागभूता या रात्रिः सोच्यते । तद्वान् । (*kṣapā rātriḥ* | *rātri paryāyayāgānāṃ stotrāṇāṃ bhāgabhūtā yā rātriḥ socyate* | *tadvān* |). By the word क्षपा (*kṣapā*) night is meant. In the sacrifices performed at night, the nights suitable for reciting hymns contain hymns of Indra; therefore Indra is possessed of क्षपा (*kṣapā*). Thus the second meaning is explained.

सः भगः राजा हि—सर्वैः भजनीयः । तत्तत्कर्मानुपफलप्रदनेन सर्वेषां राजा। (*saḥ bhagaḥ rājā hi—sarvaiḥ bhajanīyaḥ | tattatkarmānupaphalapradanena sarveṣāṃ rājā*|). Indra is one worthy of being served by all, and gives to each the fruit corresponding to his respective deeds; therefore he is the lord. And the might of the gods is described as extraordinary and pre-eminent.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वी॒रस्य॒ नु स्वश्व्यं॑ जनास॒ः प्र नु वो॑चाम वि॒दुर॑स्य दे॒वाः ।
षो॒ळ्हा यु॒क्ताः प॒ञ्च॑प॒ञ्चा व॑हन्ति म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ १८ ॥

> *vīrasya nu svaśvyaṃ janāsaḥ pra nu vocāma vidurasya devāḥ |*
> *ṣoḷhā yuktāḥ pañcapañcā vahanti mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वीरस्य । नु । सुअश्वं । जनासः । प्र । नु । वोचाम । विदुः । अस्य : देवाः ।
> षोह्ना । युक्ताः । पंचपंच । आ । वहंति । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं॥

> *vīrasya | nu | suaśvaṃ | janāsaḥ | pra | nu | vocāma | viduḥ | asya : devāḥ |*
> *ṣohnā | yuktāḥ | paṃcapaṃca | ā | vahaṃti | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे जनासो जना वीरस्य शूरस्येंद्रस्य स्वश्वं शोभनाश्वेपेतत्वं नु क्षिप्रं
> प्र वोचाम । प्रकर्षण वदाम । तथा देवा अप्यस्येंद्रस्य स्वश्वतं विदुः । जानंति ।
> किं तत्स्वश्वत्वं । तदुच्यते । षोळ्ता मासानां द्वंद्वयोगकाले षोढा दृश्यमाना
> ऋतवोऽश्वा निरूप्यंते । ते च षट्संख्याका ऋतवोः हेमंततिशिरयोः समासेन
> पंच पंच युक्ताः संतः कालात्मकमिंद्रमा वहंति । तदिदमि–द्रस्य स्वश्वत्वं यद्वृतुभिरूढत्वं ॥
> षोळ्ता । षष्शब्दात्संख्याया विधार्थे धेति धाप्रत्ययः ' षष उत्वं
> दतृदशधासूत्तरपदादेः ष्टुत्वं च । पा ६–३–१०९–३ इत्युत्वं ष्टुत्वं च।प्रत्ययस्वरः॥

> *he janāso janā vīrasya śūrasyeṃdrasya svaśvaṃ śobhanāśvepetatvaṃ nu kṣipraṃ*
> *pra vocāma | prakarṣaṇa vadāma | tathā devā apyasyeṃdrasya svaśvataṃ viduḥ | jānaṃti |*
> *kiṃ tatsvaśvatvaṃ | taducyate | ṣoḷtā māsānāṃ dvaṃdvayogakāle*

> *ṣoḍhā dṛśyamānā*
> *ṛtavo 'śvā nirūpyaṃte | te ca ṣaṭsaṃkhyākā ṛtavòḥ hemaṃtatiśirayoḥ samāsena*
> *paṃca paṃca yuktāḥ saṃtaḥ kālātmakamiṃdramā vahaṃti | tadidamidrasya svaśvatvaṃ yadvṛtubhirūḍhatvaṃ ‖ ṣoḷtā | ṣaṣśabdātsaṃkhyāyā vidhārthe dheti dhāpratyayaḥ ' ṣaṣa utvaṃ*
> *datṛdaśadhāsūttarapadādeḥ ṣṭutvaṃ ca | pā 6-3-109-3 ityutvaṃ ṣṭutvaṃ ca|pratyayasvaraḥ‖*

Summary

"O people, let us quickly proclaim the good-horsedness (स्वश्वं (*svaśvaṃ*)) of the hero, the brave Indra, that is, his being possessed of fine horses; and the gods too know his good-horsedness." What is that good-horsedness? It is explained: षोळ्हा (*ṣoḷhā*), at the time of the pairing of the months, the seasons seen as sixfold are represented as horses. Those seasons, six in number, with Hemanta and Śiśira taken together, are yoked five and five and carry Indra, who is of the nature of time. This is Indra's good-horsedness, that he is carried by the seasons. (The rest of the block is grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- जनासः (*janāsaḥ*)—O people
- वीरस्य (*vīrasya*)—of the brave Indra
- स्वश्वं (*svaśvaṃ*)—the being accompanied by horses
- नु (*nu*)—right now
- प्र वोचाम (*pra vocāma*)—we proclaim and praise
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—the gods also
- अस्य (*asya*)—this Indra's being yoked with horses
- नु (*nu*)—at once
- विदुः (*viduḥ*)—know
- षोळ्हा (*ṣoḷhā*)—the horses in the form of the six seasons
- पंचपंचयुक्ताः (*paṃcapaṃcayuktāḥ*)—(Hemanta and Śiśira being undivided) five
- आ वहंति (*ā vahaṃti*)—carry Indra
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might

- महत् (*mahat*)—great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—unique (one without a second)

Gist

People, we proclaim and praise the fact that Indra, the hero, is endowed with horses. The gods too know that Indra is endowed with horses. The horses, which are of the nature of time as the six seasons, are five in form through the union of the seasons Hemanta and Śiśira, and they carry Indra. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

We proclaim, people, the wealth of the hero, (Indra), in horses ; the gods know his (affluence) ; six, or five and five, harnessed to his car, convey him ; great and unequalled is the might of the gods,

Special Topics

षोळ्ता (*ṣoḷtā*)—मासानां द्वंद्वयोगकाले षोढा दृश्यमानाः ऋतवः अश्वाः निरूप्यंते । (*māsānāṃ dvaṃdvayogakāle ṣoḍhā dṛśyamānāḥ ṛtavaḥ aśvāḥ nirūpyaṃte* |) । ते च षट् संख्याकाः (*te ca ṣaṭ saṃkhyākāḥ*) । ऋतवः हेमंतशिशिरयोः समासेन पंचपंच युक्ताः संतः कालात्मकमिंद्रं आवहंति । (*ṛtavaḥ hemaṃtaśiśirayoḥ samāsena paṃcapaṃca yuktāḥ saṃtaḥ kālātmakamiṃdraṃ āvahaṃti* |) । तदिदं इंद्रस्य स्वश्वत्वं यदृतभिरूढत्वं (*tadidaṃ iṃdrasya svaśvatvaṃ yadṛtabhirūḍhatvaṃ*) ।

It is described that Indra is endowed with excellent horses, and that the gods too know this endowment of Indra with excellent horses: अस्य स्वश्वत्वं देवा आपि जानंति (*asya svaśvatvaṃ devā āpi jānaṃti*). The endowment with excellent horses stated here is explained by the exposition "ṣoḷhā". Indra is of the form of time; for Indra, who is of the nature of time, the twelve months combine into six pairs of seasons. Of these, if the two seasons Hemanta and Śiśira join as one, there are five seasons. Thus these seasons, five in number, are represented as five horses; these five horses carry Indra, who is of the form of time. This is what is meant by Indra's being endowed with excellent horses through the seasons. Although six seasons arise from twelve months, Hemanta and Śiśira, being possessed of one and the same kind of quality, are reckoned as one. Thus the five seasons are five horses, and they carry Indra, who is time-natured through identity with the sun; and the greatness of Indra is described as mighty.

वीरो वीरयत्यमित्रान् वेतेर्वा स्याद्गतिकर्मणः वीरयेतेर्वा (*vīro vīrayatyamitrān vetervā syādgatikarmaṇaḥ vīrayetervā*) (Ni. 1-7). Yāska explains the word vīra thus: one who destroys enemies in many ways, who goes to face the enemies and confronts them, who is endowed with valour.

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

दे॒वस्त्वष्टा॑ सवि॒ता वि॒श्वरू॑पः पु॒पोष॑ प्र॒जाः पु॑रु॒धा ज॑जान ।
इ॒मा च॒ विश्वा॒ भुव॑नान्यस्य म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒रत्व॑मेक॑म् ॥ १९ ॥

> *devastvaṣṭā savitā viśvarūpaḥ pupoṣa prajāḥ purudhā jajāna |*
> *imā ca viśvā bhuvanānyasya mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> देव । त्वष्टा । सविता । विश्वरूपः । पुपोष । प्रजाः । पुरुधा । जजान ।
> इमा । च । विश्वा । भुवनानि । अस्य । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ १९ ॥

> *deva | tvaṣṭā | savitā | viśvarūpaḥ | pupoṣa | prajāḥ | purudhā | jajāna |*
> *imā | ca | viśvā | bhuvanāni | asya | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 19 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> त्वाष्टे पशौ हविषोऽनुवाक्या देवस्त त्वष्टेतेषा । सूत्रितं च । देवस्त त्वष्टा
> सविता विश्वरूपो देव त्वष्टर्यद्ध चारुत्वमानट् । आ. ३–८ । इति ॥
> सवितांतर्यामितया सर्वस्य प्रेरको विश्वरूपो नानाविधरूपस्त्वष्टा

> त्वष्टनामको देवः प्रजाः पुरुधा बहुधा जजान । जनयति । ताश्च पुपोष ।
> पोषयति । इमेमानि विश्वा विश्वानि सर्वाणि भुवनानि भूतजातानि चास्य त्वष्टुः
> संबंधीनि ॥ विश्वरूपः । बहुव्रीहौ विश्वं संज्ञायामिति पूर्वपदांतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *tvāṣṭe paśau haviṣo 'nuvākyā devasta tvaṣṭeteṣā | sūtritaṃ ca | devasta tvaṣṭā*
> *savitā viśvarūpo deva tvaṣṭaryaddha cārutvamānaṭ | ā. 3-8 | iti ‖*
> *savitāṃtaryāmitayā sarvasya prerako viśvarūpo nānāvidharūpastvaṣṭā*
> *tvaṣṭanāmako devaḥ prajāḥ purudhā bahudhā jajāna | janayati | tāśca puposa |*
> *poṣayati | imemāni viśvā viśvāni sarvāṇi bhuvanāni bhūtajātāni cāsya tvaṣṭuḥ*
> *saṃbaṃdhīni ‖ viśvarūpaḥ | bahuvrīhau viśvaṃ saṃjñāyāmiti pūrvapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The verse is the anuvākyā for the oblation in the Tvāṣṭra animal sacrifice, the verse देवस्त त्वष्टेतेषा (*devasta tvaṣṭeteṣā*); and it is prescribed in the sūtra (Ā. Sū. 3-8).[?129] Savitā is the impeller of all as the inner controller; Tvaṣṭṛ, the god so named, of many kinds of form (viśvarūpa), begets the creatures in many ways (purudhā) and nourishes them. All these worlds, all the beings, belong to this Tvaṣṭṛ.

Word-to-word meaning

- सविता (*savitā*)—the impeller of all
- विश्वरूपः (*viśvarūpaḥ*)—the one with many kinds of form
- त्वष्टा देवः (*tvaṣṭā devaḥ*)—Tvaṣṭṛ, who is of divine nature
- प्रजाः (*prajāḥ*)—the creatures
- पुरुधा (*purudhā*)—in many ways
- जजान (*jajāna*)—creates
- पुपोष (*pupoṣa*)—(and) nourishes
- इमा विश्वा भुवनानि (*imā viśvā bhuvanāni*)—all these beings, all of them
- अस्य (*asya*)—belong to this Tvaṣṭṛ
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might

- महत् (*mahat*)—great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—extraordinary

Gist

Tvaṣṭṛ, the impeller of all, of many kinds of form, of divine nature, creates the creatures in many ways and nourishes them. All these beings too belong to that Tvaṣṭṛ. The might of the gods is great and extraordinary.

English translation

The divine Twashtri the impeller (of all), the multiform, has begotten and nourished a numerous progeny, for all these worlds are of him : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

सविता (*savitā*)—अंतर्यामितया सर्वस्य प्रेरकः (*aṃtaryāmitayā sarvasya prerakaḥ*) । Sāyaṇa explains that the word savitṛ means "one who impels everything, since he is the inner controller". Yāska explains: सविता सर्वस्य प्रसविता (*savitā sarvasya prasavitā*)—Savitā is the one who brings forth everything.

त्वष्टा देवः प्रजाः पुरुधा जजान पुपोष विश्वा भुवनानि च अस्य (*tvaṣṭā devaḥ prajāḥ purudhā jajāna pupoṣa viśvā bhuvanāni ca asya*)—तृष्णनामकः देवः प्रजाः बहुधा जनयति पोषयति (*tṛṣṇanāmakaḥ devaḥ prajāḥ bahudhā janayati poṣayati*) । इमानि सर्वाणि भूतजातानि च त्वष्टुः संबंधीनि (*imāni sarvāṇi bhūtajātāni ca tvaṣṭuḥ saṃbaṃdhīni*) । Sāyaṇa states that the god named Tvaṣṭṛ has fashioned the creatures in many ways and nourishes them, and that all these creatures belong to the god Tvaṣṭṛ.

Yāska gives the etymology of this Ṛk as follows: देवस्त्वष्टा सविता सर्वरूपः पोषति प्रजाः रसानुप्रदादेन बहुधा चेमा जनयतीमानि च सर्वाणि भूतान्वयदकान्यस्य महच्चास्मै देवानामसुरत्वमेकं प्रज्ञावत्त्वं वानवत्त्वं नापि ना । (*devastvaṣṭā savitā sarvarūpaḥ poṣati prajāḥ rasānupradādena bahudhā cemā janayatīmāni ca sarvāṇi bhūtānvayadakānyasya mahaccāsmai devānāmasuratvamekaṃ prajñāvattvaṃ vānavattvaṃ nāpi nā* |) । असुरिति प्रज्ञानाम अस्यत्यनर्थान् अस्ताश्चास्यामर्थाः (*asuriti prajñānāma asyatyanarthān astāścāsyāmarthāḥ*) । असुरत्वमादिलुप्तं

(*asuratvamādiluptaṃ*) । (Ni. 10-34) The god Tvaṣṭṛ has brought all creatures into being. By bestowing waters he nourishes and increases them. These beings and the waters belong to this god; therefore this god produces the creatures, nourishes and increases them. Hence the asuratva of this god is explained as extraordinary. He also explains the meaning of the word asura: because it averts dangers, nothing is expressible by the word asu as "intelligence", or falls outside the range of intelligence; therefore asura is said to mean "possessed of intelligence".[?130] And: असुरत्वं वसुमतो भावः वसुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ vasumato bhāvaḥ vasuratvaṃ*) । रः मत्त्वर्थे वकारलोपश्च (*raḥ mattvarthe vakāralopaśca*) वसुना उदकेन तद्वान् असौ त्वष्टा (*vasunā udakena tadvān asau tvaṣṭā*) । He explains that the word asuratva is used for vasuratva, that here "ra" is used in the sense of "possessing" and that "va" is dropped, and he gives another meaning: वसुना उदकेन तद्वान् (*vasunā udakena tadvān*)—one who is endowed with waters. Durgācārya comments: तया महत्या प्रज्ञया उदकेन साधनेन सर्वमिदं जनयति पुष्णाति वर्धयति च । (*tayā mahatyā prajñayā udakena sādhanena sarvamidaṃ janayati puṣṇāti vardhayati ca* |)—being possessed of abundant intelligence, the god Tvaṣṭṛ produces everything by means of the waters, nourishes it and increases it. In the second explanation given by him: असुरत्वं अन्नवत्त्वं (*asuratvaṃ annavattvaṃ*) । असुः प्राणः तेन तद्वत्वं (*asuḥ prāṇaḥ tena tadvatvaṃ*)—asuratva is the state of being endowed with breath; अन्नवत्त्वं तेषामन्नहेतुनोदकेन तद्वत्वं (*annavattvaṃ teṣāmannahetunodakena tadvatvaṃ*)—he is endowed with the waters that are the cause of food for the creatures.

In Sāyaṇa's explanation, विश्वा भुवनानि (*viśvā bhuvanāni*) is given the meaning सर्वाणि भूतजातानि (*sarvāṇi bhūtajātāni*)—the totality of creatures of many kinds. In the Nirukta commentators' explanation, सर्वाणि भूतानि उदकानि (*sarvāṇi bhūtāni udakāni*)—he makes all creatures and the waters, nourishes and increases them; thus a difference can be seen. A difference is also seen in the explanation of the meaning of the word asuratva.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒ही समै॑रच्च॒म्वा॑ समी॒ची उ॒भे ते अ॑स्य॒ वसु॑ना॒ न्यृ॑ष्टे ।
शृ॒ण्वे वी॒रो वि॒न्दमा॑नो॒ वसू॑नि म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ २० ॥

> *mahī samairaccamvā samīcī ubhe te asya vasunā nyṛṣṭe |*
> *śṛṇve vīro vindamāno vasūni mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मही इति । सम् । ऐरत् । चम्या । समीची इति सम्ईची । उभे इति । ते इति ।
> अस्य । वसुना । नृष्टे इति निऋष्टे ।
> शृण्वे । वीरः । विंदमानः । वसूनि । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ २० ॥

> *mahī iti | sam | airat | camyā | samīcī iti samīcī | ubhe iti | te iti |*
> *asya | vasunā | nṛṣṭe iti nirṣṭe |*
> *śṛṇve | vīraḥ | viṃdamānaḥ | vasūni | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ |*
> *ekaṃ ‖ 20 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मही महत्वा समीचि परस्परं संगते चम्वा चमंत्यदंत्यनयोर्देवमनुष्या इति चम्वौ । यद्वा चम्येते आद्येते भूतजातैरिति चम्वौ द्यावापृथिव्यौ ।
> समैरत् । इंद्रः प्रजापश्वादिभिः सम्यगयोजयत् । ते उभे द्यावापृथिव्यावस्येंद्रस्य वसुना तेजसा धनेन वा नृष्टे निकरां व्याप्ते भवतः।वीरः समर्थः स इंद्रो
> वसूनि शत्रूनभिभूय तदीयानि धनानि विंदमानो लभमानः सन् श्वण्वे । सर्वैः
> श्रूयते । तवेदिदमभितश्चेकिते वसु। ऋग्वे. १–५३–३ । इत्यादिषु दृष्टत्वात् ॥ ऐरत्।
> ईर गतावित्यस्य लजि रूपं । नृष्टे । ऋषी गतौ । कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः
> स्वरः । शृण्वे । श्रु श्रवण इत्यस्य व्यत्ययेन कर्मणि श्नुः । लोपस्त आत्मनेपदेष्टिति
> तलोपः । विंदमानः । विद्लृ लाभ इत्यस्य लटि शानचि रूपं । तस्य लसार्वधातुकस्वरे
> धातुस्वरः ॥

> *mahī mahatvā samīci parasparaṃ saṃgate camvā*
> *camaṃtyadaṃtyanayordevamanuṣyā iti camvau | yadvā camyete ādyete*
> *bhūtajātairiti camvau dyāvāpṛthivyau |*
> *samairat | iṃdraḥ prajāpaśvādibhiḥ samyagayojayat | te ubhe*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyāvasyeṃdrasya vasunā tejasā dhanena vā nṛṣṭe nikarāṃ*
> *vyāpte bhavataḥ|vīraḥ samarthaḥ sa iṃdro*
> *vasūni śatrūnabhibhūya tadīyāni dhanāni viṃdamāno labhamānaḥ san*
> *śvaṇve | sarvaiḥ*
> *śrūyate | tavedidamabhitaścekite vasu| ṛgve. 1-53-3 | ityādiṣu dṛṣṭatvāt*
> *‖ airat|*
> *īra gatāvityasya laji rūpaṃ | nṛṣṭe | ṛṣī gatau | karmaṇi ktaḥ |*
> *gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ*
> *svaraḥ | śṛṇve | śru śravaṇa ityasya vyatyayena karmaṇi śnuḥ | lopasta*
> *ātmanepadeṣṭiti*
> *talopaḥ | viṃdamānaḥ | vidla lābha ityasya laṭi śānaci rūpaṃ | tasya*
> *lasārvadhātukasvare*
> *dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

चम्वा (*camvā*) (dual) are the two that are "chewed", for in them gods and men eat (चमंत्यदंत्यनयोर्देवमनुष्या इति (*camaṃtyadaṃtyanayordevamanuṣyā iti*)); or else they are the two that are eaten by the creatures—heaven and earth. "Mahī" means great, "samīcī" mutually joined. समैरत् (*samairat*): Indra joined them well with creatures, animals and the rest. Both heaven and earth are pervaded by this Indra's वसुना (*vasunā*)—by his splendour or by his wealth. वीरः (*vīraḥ*) means capable. That Indra, overcoming his enemies and obtaining their wealth (वसूनि (*vasūni*)), is heard of by all; for this is seen in such passages as तवेदिदमभितश्चेकिते वसु (*tavedidamabhitaścekite vasu*) (Ṛgve. 1-53-3).?131

Word-to-word meaning

- मही (*mahī*)—those of great nature
- समीची (*samīcī*)—and joined together
- चम्वा (*camvā*)—heaven and earth

- सम्मैरत् (*sammairat*)—(Indra) made them endowed with creatures
- ते उभे (*te ubhe*)—both of them, heaven and earth
- अस्य (*asya*)—of Indra
- वसुना (*vasunā*)—by the splendour
- नृष्टे (*nṛṣṭe*)—are pervaded
- वीरः (*vīraḥ*)—the capable Indra
- वसूनि (*vasūni*)—the wealth of enemies
- विंदमानः (*viṃdamānaḥ*)—as one who seizes
- शृण्वे (*śṛṇve*)—is heard of as well known
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—unique

Gist

Indra made heaven and earth, which are of great nature and joined together, endowed with creatures. Both heaven and earth are pervaded by Indra's splendour. It is well known that Indra, the capable, seizes the wealth of enemies. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

He has filled the two vast receptacles (heaven and earth) united (with creatures): they are both penetrated by his lustre: the hero spoiling the treasures (of the foe) is renowned : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

चम्वा (*camvā*)—चमंति अदंति अनयोः देवमनुष्याः इति चम्वा (*camaṃti adaṃti anayoḥ devamanuṣyāḥ iti camvā*) । यद्वा चम्येते अद्येते भूतजात्यैरिति चम्वा द्यावापृथिव्यौ । (*yadvā camyete adyete bhūtajātyairiti camvā dyāvāpṛthivyau* |) । The word chamvā is stated among the names of heaven and earth (Ni. 3-22). Since they are the cause of the production of food fit to be eaten by gods and men, and since they are consumed by all creatures, heaven and earth are designated by the word chamvā.

वसुना (*vasunā*)—तेजसा धनेन वा (*tejasā dhanena vā*) । The word vasu is stated among the names of rays (Ni. 2-15) and among the names of wealth (Ni. 3-9); and in सुगुर सत्सुहिरण्यः (*sugura satsuhiraṇyaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-1-18) it is used in the sense वसुना अन्नेन (*vasunā annena*)—"with food". And it is also explained: वसवः आदित्यरश्मयः (*vasavaḥ ādityaraśmayaḥ*) (Ni. 12-42)—the rays of the sun. Here it is described that heaven and earth are pervaded by Indra's splendours and wealth, pervaded by Indra's lordliness.

वीरः वसूनि विंदमानः शृण्वे (*vīraḥ vasūni viṃdamānaḥ śṛṇve*)—समर्थः सः इंद्रः शत्रूनभिभूय तदीयानि धनानि लभमानस्सर् (*samarthaḥ saḥ iṃdraḥ śatrūnabhibhūya tadīyāni dhanāni labhamānassar*) सर्वैः श्रूयते (*sarvaiḥ śrūyate*)?132—having explained that the heroic Indra subdues his enemies and seizes their wealth, he describes that this matter is stated in the Ṛk तवेदिदमभितश्चेकिते वसु (*tavedidamabhitaścekite vasu*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-53-3).

Ṛk 21

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मां च॑ नः पृथि॒वीं वि॒श्वधा॑या॒ उप॑ क्षेति हि॒तमि॑त्रो॒ न राजा॑ ।
पु॒र॒ःसद॑ः शर्म॒सदो॒ न वी॒रा म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॒क॑म् ॥ २१ ॥

> *imāṃ ca naḥ pṛthivīṃ viśvadhāyā upa kṣeti hitamitro na rājā |*
> *puraḥsadaḥ śarmasado na vīrā mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 21 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमां । च । नः । पृथिवीं । विश्वधायाः । उप । क्षेति । हितमित्रः ! न ! राजा ।
> पुरःसदः । शर्मसदः । न । वीराः । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ २१ ॥

> *imāṃ | ca | naḥ | pṛthivīṃ | viśvadhāyāḥ | upa | kṣeti | hitamitraḥ ! na ! rājā |*
> *puraḥsadaḥ | śarmasadaḥ | na | vīrāḥ | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 21 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वधाया विश्वस्य धाता सर्वान्नो ना नोऽस्माकं राजेंद्र इमां पृथिवीमंतरिक्षं चोप तयोः समीपे क्षेति । निवसति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । हितमित्रो न । यथा
> कस्यचित् हितोपदेष्टा सुहृत्समीपे निवसति तद्वत् । वीराः समर्था युद्धसहाया
> मरुतः पुरःसदो युद्धार्थं पुरतो निश्चयेन गंतार इंद्रस्य शर्मसदः । न
> चार्थे । शर्मणि गृहे सीदंतश्च भवंति । यत्र यत्रासौ तत्र तत्र संनिधिं कुर्वाणा
> इत्यर्थः ॥ क्षेति । क्षि निवासगत्योरित्यस्य लटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । निघातः ॥

> *viśvadhāyā viśvasya dhātā sarvānno nā no 'smākaṃ rājeṃdra imāṃ pṛthivīmaṃtarikṣaṃ copa tayoḥ samīpe kṣeti | nivasati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | hitamitro na | yathā*
> *kasyacit hitopadeṣṭā suhṛtsamīpe nivasati tadvat | vīrāḥ samarthā yuddhasahāyā*
> *marutaḥ puraḥsado yuddhārthaṃ purato niścayena gaṃtāra iṃdrasya śarmasadaḥ | na*
> *cārthe | śarmaṇi gṛhe sīdaṃtaśca bhavaṃti | yatra yatrāsau tatra tatra saṃnidhiṃ kurvāṇā*
> *ityarthaḥ ‖ kṣeti | kṣi nivāsagatyorityasya laṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

विश्वधायाः (*viśvadhāyāḥ*) is the supporter of all. Our king Indra dwells near this earth and the atmosphere, close to them. The illustration: हितमित्रो न (*hitamitro na*)—as a friend who gives beneficial counsel dwells near one's side. The वीराः (*vīrāḥ*) are the capable Maruts, helpers in battle, पुरःसदः (*puraḥsadaḥ*)—those who go resolutely before Indra for battle; शर्मसदः (*śarmasadaḥ*)—here न (*na*) is in the sense of "and" (न चार्थे (*na cārthe*)): they are also seated in his house (śarman); the meaning is that wherever he is, there they keep close at hand.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वधायाः (*viśvadhāyāḥ*)—the supporter of the whole world
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- राजा (*rājā*)—the lord, Indra
- हितमित्रो न (*hitamitro na*)—like a friend who wishes one well
- इमां पृथिवीं उप (*imāṃ pṛthivīṃ upa*)—in the atmosphere near this earth
- क्षेति (*kṣeti*)—dwells
- वीराः (*vīrāḥ*)—the capable Maruts
- पुरःसदः (*puraḥsadaḥ*)—going in front of him (in battle)
- शर्मसदः (*śarmasadaḥ*)—dwell in his very house
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—extraordinary

Gist

Indra, the supporter of the whole world and our lord, dwells like a friend who wishes us well in the firmament nearest to this earth. The valiant Maruts go in front of him in battle and dwell in his own house. The might of the gods is great and unequalled.

English translation

Our king, the nourisher of all, abides (in the firmament) nearest to this earth like a benevolent friend : the valiant (Maruts) precede him (when abroad), and dwell in his mansion : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

विश्वध्वायाः नः राजा इमां पृथिवीं च उप क्षेति (*viśvadhvāyāḥ naḥ rājā imāṃ pṛthivīṃ ca upa kṣeti*): the meaning is explained as follows. Indra, who supports and nourishes the whole universe, or who enjoys everything, is king and protector for us, the sacrificers, and dwells close to earth and the firmament. For this, the illustration हितमित्रो न (*hitamitro na*) is given: just as a friend who counsels one's welfare always lives nearby, so Indra, staying near earth and the firmament, is described as one who thinks of our good.

वीराः (*vīrāḥ*): the able Maruts, helpers in battle. Although the word "vīra" is conventionally used in the sense of "hero", here it is used in the sense that the Marut deities are heroes and help Indra in times of battle.

पुरसदः शर्मसदो न (*purasadaḥ śarmasado na*): these Maruts are those who go in front of Indra in battle and who also dwell in Indra's house; they are present wherever he is. The meaning is explained thus: the Maruts stay in front of Indra and help in times of battle, and they dwell in all the places where Indra is. The particle "na" is stated to have the sense of comparison and also the sense of prohibition (Ni. 1-4); here that particle is given the sense of the particle "ca", that of combination.

Ṛk 22

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नि॒ष्षिध्व॑रीस्त॒ ओष॑धीरु॒तापो॑ र॒यिं त॑ इन्द्र पृथि॒वी बि॑भर्ति ।
सखा॑यस्ते वाम॒भाज॑ः स्याम म॒हद्दे॒वाना॑मसु॒र॒त्वमे॑कम् ॥ २२ ॥

> *niṣṣidhvarīsta oṣadhīrutāpo rayiṃ ta indra pṛthivī bibharti |*
> *sakhāyaste vāmabhājaḥ syāma mahaddevānāmasuratvamekam ‖ 22 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> निःसिध्वरीः । ते । ओषधीः । उत । आपः । रयिं । ते । इंद्र । पृथिवी । बिभर्ति ।
> सखायः ते । वामभाजः । स्याम । महत् । देवानां । असुरत्वं । एकं ॥ २२ ॥

> *niḥsidhvarīḥ | te | oṣadhīḥ | uta | āpaḥ | rayiṃ | te | iṃdra | pṛthivī | bibharti |*
> *sakhāyaḥ te | vāmabhājaḥ | syāma | mahat | devānāṃ | asuratvaṃ | ekaṃ ‖ 22 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे पर्जनात्मककेंद्र ओषधीरोषधयस्ते निष्पिध्वरीर्निष्पिध्वयो नितरां
> त्वत्कर्तृकसिद्धिमत्यः । उतापि च आपस्त्वत्तो निःसृताः । पृथिवी ते तव भोगयोग्यं
> रयिं धनं बिभर्ति । पुरू वसूनि पृथिवी बिभर्ति । ऋग्वे. ३–५१–५ । इति हि निगमः ।
> ततस्ते तव सखायो हविष्पदा नोपकारकाः स्तोतारो वयं वामभाजः स्याम।
> सर्वे वननीयधनभागिनो भवेम । तदेतद्देवानां महदैश्वर्यं ॥ निष्पिध्वरीः ।
> षिधु संरादौ । संपदादिलक्षणो भावे क्विप् । तदस्यास्तित्यर्थे छंदसीवनिपाविति
> वनिप् । वनो र चेति जीप् रेफश्च । निसा सह समासः । निसः सकारं
> छांदसत्वादनादृत्योपसर्गात्सुनोतीत्यादिना षत्वं । जीपः पित्त्वा दनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्करः ।
> बिभर्ति।
> डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्य लटि बृञामिदित्यभ्यासस्येत्वं । निघातः । वामभाजः । भज
> सेवायां । भजो ण्वैः । पा ३–२–६२ । इति ण्वैः । कृदुत्तरपदस्वरः ॥

> *he parjanātmakakeṃdra oṣadhīroṣadhayaste niṣpidhvarīrniṣpidhvayo nitarāṃ*
> *tvatkartṛkasiddhimatyaḥ | utāpi ca āpastvatto niḥsṛtāḥ | pṛthivī te tava bhogayogyaṃ*
> *rayiṃ dhanaṃ bibharti | purū vasūni pṛthivī bibharti | ṛgve. 3-51-5 | iti hi nigamaḥ |*
> *tataste tava sakhāyo haviṣpadā nopakārakāḥ stotāro vayaṃ vāmabhājaḥ syāma|*
> *sarvè vananīyadhanabhāgino bhavema | tadetaddevānāṃ mahadaiśvaryaṃ ‖ niṣpidhvarīḥ |*
> *ṣidhu saṃrādau | saṃpadādilakṣaṇo bhāve kvip | tadasyāstityarthe chaṃdasīvanipāviti*
> *vanip | vano ra ceti jīp rephaśca | nisā saha samāsaḥ | nisaḥ sakāraṃ*
> *chāṃdasatvādanādṛtyopasargātsunotītyādinā ṣatvaṃ | jīpaḥ pittvā danudāttatve dhātuskaraḥ | bibharti|*
> *ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasya laṭi bṛñāmidityabhyāsasyètvaṃ | nighātaḥ | vāmabhājaḥ | bhaja sevāyāṃ | bhajo ṇvaiḥ | pā 3-2-62 | iti ṇvaiḥ | kṛduttarapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, in the form of Parjanya (the rain-god): the plants (ओषधीः (*oṣadhīḥ*)) are निष्पिध्वरीः (*niṣpidhvarīḥ*), that is, brought fully to perfection through you; and the waters also flow forth from you. The earth bears for you wealth fit for your enjoyment; Sāyaṇa cites the Nigama "Earth bears abundant treasures" (Ṛgve. 3-51-5). Therefore we, your friends and praisers who help you with offerings, would be वामभाजः (*vāmabhājaḥ*), sharers of all desirable wealth. That is the great lordship of the gods.[?133]

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra, who are of the nature of Parjanya
- ओषधीः (*oṣadhīḥ*)—all the plants also
- ते (*te*)—by you alone
- निष्पिध्वरीः (*niṣpidhvarīḥ*)—obtain nourishment and fullness of sap
- उत (*uta*)—and
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters also flow forth from you alone
- पृथिवी (*pṛthivī*)—the earth
- ते (*te*)—for you
- रयिं (*rayiṃ*)—wealth
- बिभर्ति (*bibharti*)—has borne
- ते (*te*)—to you
- सखायः (*sakhāyaḥ*)—we, who are your friends
- नामभाजः स्याम (*nāmabhājaḥ syāma*)—may we enjoy all these riches[?134]
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods
- असुरत्वं (*asuratvaṃ*)—the might
- महत् (*mahat*)—is great
- एकं (*ekaṃ*)—and unique

Gist

O Indra, of the nature of Parjanya, all the plants also receive nourishment and fullness of sap from you alone. The waters flow forth from you alone. The earth has borne wealth for you. May we, your friends, enjoy all this wealth. The might of the gods is great and unique.[?135]

English translation

The plants, Indra, come to perfection by you : from you the waters (flow) ; earth bears her treasures for you : may we, your friends, be sharers of these blessings : great and unequalled is the might of the gods.

Special Topics

Addressing him with the word Indra, it is described that Indra, being the giver of rain to the worlds, performs the acts of producing, nourishing and increasing everything, and is therefore of the nature of Parjanya.

सखायः वामभाजः स्याम (*sakhāyaḥ vāmabhājaḥ syāma*): we, the helpers and praisers by the offering of oblations, would all be sharers of desirable wealth. It is described that the sacrificers wish Indra's welfare by offering oblations to him and by praising him; it is further explained that these sacrificers hope to obtain from Indra the wealth that is necessary for performing sacrifices and the like, and that the great might of the gods is chief and unequalled.

Closing verse and colophon: वेदार्थस्य प्रकाशेन तमो हार्दं निवारयन् । पुमर्थांश्च तुरो देयाद्विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरः ॥ (*vedārthasya prakāśena tamo hārdaṃ nivārayan | pumarthāṃśca turo deyādvidyātīrthamaheśvaraḥ* ‖) इति श्रीमद्राजाधिराजपरमेश्वरवैदिकमार्गप्रवर्तकश्रीवीरबुक्क भूपालसाम्राज्यधुरंधरेण सायणाचार्येण विरचिते माधवीये वेदार्थप्रकाशे ऋक्संहिताभाष्ये तृतीयाष्टके तृतीयोऽध्यायः समाप्तः (*iti śrīmadrājādhirājaparameśvaravaidikamārgapravartakaśrīvīrabukka bhūpālasāmrājyadhuraṃdhareṇa sāyaṇācāryeṇa viracite mādhavīye vedārthaprakāśe ṛksaṃhitābhāṣye tṛtīyāṣṭake tṛtīyo 'dhyāyaḥ samāptaḥ*) यदक्षरपदभ्रष्टं मात्राहीनं तु यद्भवेत् । तत्सर्वं क्षम्यता० देव वागीश्वर नमोऽस्तु ते (*yadakṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ tu yadbhavet | tatsarvaṃ*

kṣamyatāo deva vāgīśvara namo 'stu te) May there be auspiciousness. Blessing. ओं तस्यत् (*oṃ tasyat*). Here ends the third chapter in the third Aṣṭaka of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, with the bhāṣya of Śrī Sāyaṇa and the Kannada translation.

Om. Śrī. Obeisance to the great lord of the troops. वागीशाद्याः सुमनसः सर्वार्थानामुपक्रमे यं नत्वा कृतकृत्याः स्युस्तं नमामि गजाननं ॥ (*vāgīśādyāḥ sumanasaḥ sarvārthānāmupakrame yaṃ natvā kṛtakṛtyāḥ syustaṃ namāmi gajānanaṃ* ‖) यस्य निश्यसितं वेदा यो वेदेभ्योऽखिलं जगत् । निर्ममे तमहं वंदे विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरं ॥ (*yasya niśyasitaṃ vedā yo vedebhyo 'khilaṃ jagat* | *nirmame tamahaṃ vaṃde vidyātīrthamaheśvaraṃ* ‖) तृतीयाष्टकमध्यस्थः तृतीयोऽध्याय आदरात् । व्याख्यातः सायणार्येण चतुर्थो व्याकरिष्यते ॥ (*tṛtīyāṣṭakamadhyasthaḥ tṛtīyo 'dhyāya ādarāt* | *vyākhyātaḥ sāyaṇāryèṇa caturtho vyākariṣyate* ‖) वेदः शिवः शिवो वेदो वेदाध्यायी सदाशिवः । तस्मात्सर्वप्रयत्नेन वेदमेव सदा जपेत् ॥ (*vedaḥ śivaḥ śivo vedo vedādhyāyī sadāśivaḥ* | *tasmātsarvaprayatnena vedameva sadā japet* ‖)

Ṛgveda Saṃhitā with the Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya. The fourth chapter in the third Aṣṭaka. (Sūktas 56-62 of the third Maṇḍala and Sūktas 1-4 of the fourth Maṇḍala.)

In this chapter, beginning with the 56th Sūkta of the third Maṇḍala, the third Maṇḍala ends with the 62nd Sūkta. Although the Viśvedevas are the deity of this Sūkta, the Āditya, the year and its divisions are praised. Because in many places there are no words indicating a definite meaning, and because room is left for many kinds of meanings, it is not possible to say that the seer's intention for many of the matters stated in this Sūkta is just so. Nevertheless, following the Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya, we have given the explanation of the meaning in accordance with Yāska's etymologies.

Sūkta 56 (Maṇḍala 3)

The fifty-sixth Sūkta.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> न ता मिनंतीत्यष्टर्चं तृतीयं सूक्तं विश्वामित्रस्य वाचः पुत्रस्य ना प्रजापतेरार्षं त्रैष्टुभं वैश्वदेवं ।
> तथा चानुक्रमणिका । न ताष्टाविति। सूक्तविनियोगो
> लिंगादवगंतव्यः । अस्मिन्सूक्ते प्रायेणादित्यैः सह संवत्सरः स्तूयते ॥

> *na tā minaṃtītyaṣṭarcaṃ tṛtīyaṃ sūktaṃ viśvāmitrasya vācaḥ putrasya nā prajāpaterārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ vaiśvadevaṃ | tathā cānukramaṇikā | na tāṣṭāviti| sūktaviniyogo*
> *liṃgādavagaṃtavyaḥ | asminsūkte prāyeṇādityaiḥ saha saṃvatsaraḥ stūyate ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn beginning न ता मिनंति (*na tā minaṃti*), of eight ṛks, is the third sūkta. Its seer is Prajāpati, the son of Viśvāmitra, or Vācya, son of Vāc; the metre is Triṣṭubh and the deity the Viśvedevas. The Anukramaṇikā says न ताष्टाविति (*na tāṣṭāviti*). The use of the sūkta in ritual is to be understood from the indication (liṅga) of its content. In this sūkta, for the most part, the year is praised together with the Ādityas.

Anuvāda: This Sūkta beginning "na tā minanti" is the third Sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has eight ṛks. Its seer is Prajāpati or Vācya, the son of Viśvāmitra; the deity is the Viśvedevas; the metre is Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā says "na tāṣṭau". The use of the Sūkta is to be understood according to the meaning of the ṛks. In this Sūkta the year is for the most part praised together with the Āditya.

Om. Sūkta 56. Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 5; Sūkta 56. Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 4; Varga 1. Number of ṛks in the Sūkta: 8. Seer: Prajāpati Vaiśvāmitra or Vācya. Deity: the Viśvedevas. Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

न ता मि॑नन्ति मा॒यिनो॒ न धीरा॑ व्र॒ता दे॒वानां॑ प्रथ॒मा ध्रु॒वाणि॑ ।
न रोद॑सी अ॒द्रुहा॑ वे॒द्याभि॒र्न पर्व॑ता नि॒नमे॑ तस्थि॒वांस॑ः ॥ १ ॥

> *na tā minanti māyino na dhīrā vratā devānāṃ prathamā dhruvāṇi |*
> *na rodasī adruhā vedyābhirna parvatā niname tasthivāṃsaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> न । ता । मिनंति । मायिनः । न । धीराः । व्रता । देवानां । प्रथमा । ध्रुवाणि ।
> न । रोदसी इति । अद्रुहा । वेद्याभिः । न । पर्वताः । निनमे । तसि ऽवांसः ॥ १ ॥

> *na | tā | minaṃti | māyinaḥ | na | dhīrāḥ | vratā | devānām |*
> *prathamā | dhruvāṇi |*
> *na | rodasī iti | adruhā | vedyābhiḥ | na | parvatāḥ | niname | tasi*
> *'vāṃsaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मायिनः कपटबुद्ध्युपेता असुरा देवानामिंद्रादीनां प्रथमा प्रथमानि सृष्ट्यनंतरभावीनि ध्रुवाणि स्थिराणि केनापि चालयितुमशक्यानि ता तानि लोके प्रसिद्धानि व्रता व्रतानि लोकपालनादिकर्माणि न मिनंति । न हिंसंति । तथा धीरा विद्वांसोऽपि न हिंसंति । तथाद्रुहा देवमनुष्यादिषु प्रजासु द्रोहवर्जिते रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्य वेद्याभिः स्वाश्रयतया सर्वैर्वेदनीयाभिः प्रजाभिः सहितानि कर्माणि न मिनीतः । तदेतदुपपादयति । तस्थिवांसः पृथिव्यामूर्ध्वतया स्थिताः पर्वता न निनमे । निनमनीया न भवंति । एतदुक्तं भवति । यद्देवमनुष्यादीनां द्यावापृथिव्याधारकतयावस्थापनं यच्च पर्वतादीनामुन्नततयावस्थापनं तदिदं देवानां कर्म । तन्न कोऽप्यन्यथयितुमर्हतीति ॥ मिनंति । मीज् हिंसायामित्यस्य लटि मीनातेर्निगम इति ह्रस्वः । निघातः । वेद्याभिः । वेदनमर्हंति । छंदसि चेति यत्पत्ययः । निनमे । णमु प्रह्वत्व इत्यस्य कृत्यार्थे केन्प्रत्ययः । कृत्स्वरः ॥

> *māyinaḥ kapaṭabuddhupetā asurā devānāmiṃdrādīnāṃ prathamā prathamāni*
> *sṛṣṭyanaṃtarabhāvīni dhruvāṇi sthirāṇi kenāpi cālayitumaśakyāni tā tāni loke*
> *prasiddhāni vratā vratāni lokapālanādikarmāṇi na minaṃti | na hiṃsaṃti | tathā dhīrā*
> *vidvāṃso 'pi na hiṃsaṃti | tathādruhā devamanuṣyādiṣu prajāsu drohavarjite*
> *rodasī dyāvāpṛthivya vedyābhiḥ svāśrayatayā sarvairvedanīyābhiḥ prajābhiḥ sahitāni*
> *karmāṇi na minītaḥ | tadetadupapādayati | tasthivāṃsaḥ pṛthivyāmūrdhvatayā sthitāḥ*
> *parvatā na niname | ninamanīyā na bhavaṃti | etaduktaṃ bhavati | yaddevamanuṣyādīnāṃ*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyādhārakatayāvasthāpanaṃ yacca parvatādīnāmunnatatayāvasthāpanaṃ tadidaṃ*
> *devānāṃ karma | tanna ko 'pyanyathayitumarhatīti ‖ minaṃti | mīṇ hiṃsāyāmityasya*
> *laṭi mīnāternigama iti hrasvaḥ | nighātaḥ | vedyābhiḥ | vedanamarhaṃti | chaṃdasi ceti*
> *yatpatyayaḥ | niname | ṇamu prahvatva ityasya kṛtyārthe kenpratyayaḥ | kṛtsvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

The मायिनः (*māyinaḥ*) are the asuras, endowed with a deceitful mind. The acts (व्रता (*vratā*)) of the gods, Indra and the rest, that is, the works such as protecting the world, are प्रथमा (*prathamā*), coming first after creation, and ध्रुवाणि (*dhruvāṇi*), firm, impossible for anyone to move, and well known in the world. These the asuras do not मिनंति (*minaṃti*), that is, do not injure; likewise the wise (धीरा (*dhīrā*)) do not injure them. Likewise रोदसी (*rodasī*), heaven and earth, free from hostility (अद्रुहा (*adruhā*)) toward the beings of gods, men and the rest, do not injure the works together with the beings, वेद्याभिः (*vedyābhiḥ*), who are known to all through their dependence on them. He substantiates this: the mountains (पर्वता (*parvatā*)) standing (तस्थिवांसः (*tasthivāṃsaḥ*)) high on the earth are not निनमे (*niname*), they are not to be bowed down. What is meant: the establishing of gods, men and the rest as the supporters of heaven and earth, and the setting up of mountains and the like as lofty, are the works of the gods; no one is able to alter them.

Word-to-word meaning

- मायिनः (*māyinaḥ*)—the deceitful asuras
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the gods, Indra and others
- प्रथमा (*prathamā*)—most ancient and chief
- ध्रुवाणि (*dhruvāṇi*)—firm
- ता (*tā*)—and well-known
- व्रता (*vratā*)—acts such as protecting the world
- न मिनंति (*na minaṃti*)—cannot injure and obstruct
- धीराः (*dhīrāḥ*)—even the wise and discerning
- न (मिनंति) (*na (minaṃti)*)—cannot injure
- अद्रुहा (*adruhā*)—free from hostility
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth also
- वेद्याभिः (*vedyābhiḥ*)—together with their communities of beings, evident to all
- न (मिनीतः) (*na (minītaḥ)*)—cannot injure
- तस्थिवांसः (*tasthivāṃsaḥ*)—firmly established
- पर्वताः (*parvatāḥ*)—mountains
- न निनमे (*na niname*)—(because they are established by Indra and the others) no one can lower their loftiness

Gist

Neither the deceitful asuras nor the wise and discerning can injure and obstruct the most ancient, firm and well-known acts of the gods, such as protecting the world. Even heaven and earth, free from hostility, cannot obstruct them. The loftiness of the mountains and the like, set high upon the earth, is also the work of Indra and the others, so no one can lower them.

English translation

Neither the deceptive nor the resolute interrupt the primitive and permanent operations of the gods, nor do the innocuous heaven and earth (interrupt them), nor are the mountains standing (on the earth) to be bowed down.

Special Topics

The power of the works of Indra and the others, such as protecting the world, is the matter of this mantra. The affairs of the universe go on in accordance with the law of the seasons (ṛtu-dharma). All activities that proceed in conformity with and in support of this rule are called vrata. The breaking of this vrata of Indra and the others cannot be effected by anyone. However deceitful and powerful the asuras may be, they cannot break these vratas. The wise and steadfast follow this same vrata, so no breach arises from them either. Therefore the affairs of the universe proceed in order just as was resolved before creation; thus the steadiness of the cosmic order is praised.

The cosmic order can be broken by two kinds of power. It may be attempted by demonic power, which hates divine culture and acts with deceit to gain selfish ends. Or poets who are filled with divine power itself, who are wise, and who can independently produce creation in accordance with Brahma's creation, may be able to break it. But there is ample basis for saying that in the affairs of the universe divine power has greater strength than demonic power. Therefore the breaking of the vrata of Indra and the others is not possible for the asuras or persons with demonic power; and since the steadfast poets and the wise have resolved to promote divine culture itself, they too cannot break this law. This is what is suggested in this mantra.

मायिनः (*māyinaḥ*): this word is explained as the asuras endowed with a deceitful mind. The word māyā is used in many places in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā to denote an extraordinary special power. There are contexts in which it also means an independent creative power. The epithet here denotes the creative power of the gods Indra and the others. Therefore, to understand the purport of the word in the present place, one must know in what contexts the word is used elsewhere in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā.

Broadly it can be said that this word is used in four main senses: as divine creative power, as merely physical power, as stratagem, or as the art of magic (indrajāla). It can be said to be derived from the root माज् माने (*māj māne*)[?136], which has the sense of creation.

"Māyā means prajñā (intelligence)": मायेति प्रज्ञानाम । माया, वयुनं इति तन्नामसु पाठात् । (नि. ३-१३) (*māyeti prajñānāma | māyā, vayunaṃ iti tannāmasu pāṭhāt | (ni. 3-13)*) Thus the Nirukta-writers have explained this word as prajñā. Citing the Ṛks मायामू तु यज्ञियानां (*māyāmū tu yajñiyānāṃ*) (10-88-6) and शुक्रंते अन्यद्यजतं ते (*śukraṃ te anyadyajataṃ te*) (6-58-1), the appropriateness of taking the word as prajñā there was explained earlier (Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, Part 11, p. 514).

रूपंरूपं प्रतिरूपो बभूव तदस्य रूपं प्रतिचक्षणाय । इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते युक्ता ह्यस्य हरयः शता दश ॥ (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ pratirūpo babhūva tadasya rūpaṃ praticakṣaṇāya | iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate yuktā hyasya harayaḥ śatā daśa ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-18)

This well-known mantra describes Indra's power of māyā. It is also recited in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka. Sāyaṇa explains this mantra in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā in two ways. First: मायाभिः—ज्ञानमेतत् । ज्ञानैः । आत्मीयैः संकल्पैः (*māyābhiḥ—jñānametat | jñānaiḥ | ātmīyaiḥ saṃkalpaiḥ*)—by cognitions that are of the nature of his own resolves Indra took on manifold forms. Second: इदि परमैश्वरै इत्यस्य धातोरर्थानुगमात् इंद्रः परमात्मा । स चाकाशवत् सर्वगतः सदानंदरूपः (*idi paramaiśvarai ityasya dhātorarthānugamāt iṃdraḥ paramātmā | sa cākāśavat sarvagataḥ sadānaṃdarūpaḥ*)—the word Indra is formed from the root id, which gives the sense "lord of the whole universe"; therefore Indra here means the Supreme Self. He explains that the all-pervading Supreme Person is transformed, by his powers of māyā, into the form of the world beginning with ether. In both constructions the word māyā is taken as creative power. Moreover, Śaṅkarācārya too explains this mantra in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka in two ways: first प्रज्ञाभिः (*prajñābhiḥ*), by intelligences that effect creation; second नामरूपभूतकृतमिथ्याभिमानैर्वा

(*nāmarūpabhūtakṛtamithyābhimānairvā*), that is, by powers of imagining such as "I" and "form". Here too the purport of the word is creative power. Power of imagination means mental creation. Mental creation may lack physical reality, but creative power must be present. For both kinds of power the synonym māyā is used in many places. Likewise:

माया वां मित्रावरुणा दिवि श्रिता सूरो ज्योतिश्चरति चित्रमायुधं । तमभ्रेण वृष्ट्या गूहथो दिवि पर्जन्य द्रप्सा मधुमंत ईरते ॥ (*māyā vāṃ mitrāvaruṇā divi śritā sūro jyotiścarati citramāyudhaṃ | tamabhreṇa vṛṣṭyā gūhatho divi parjanya drapsā madhumaṃta īrate ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-63-4)

In all such places the extraordinary intelligence and creative power of Mitra and Varuṇa are described. Likewise, in the previously cited mantras such as मही मित्रस्य वरुण्य माया (*mahī mitrasya varuṇya māyā*) there is no room for the sense "ignorance" for māyā. In पूर्वापरं चरतो माययौता (*pūrvāparaṃ carato māyayautā*) (10-85-18) it is said that the Sun and Moon travel in the atmosphere by their special power of intelligence; there is no imagination in this, it is physical truth. Therefore, as stated in the Sūtra-bhāṣya and the like,

there is no room for the sense of ignorance or imagination. This meaning becomes clear if one examines the mantra cited in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa in the Pravargya section:

पतंगमक्तमसुरस्य मायया हृदा पश्यंति मनसा विपश्चितः । समुद्रे अंतः कवयो वि चक्षते मॆरीचीनां पदमिच्छंति वेधसः (*pataṃgamaktamasurasya māyayā hṛdā paśyaṃti manasā vipaścitaḥ | samudre aṃtaḥ kavayo vi cakṣate mèrīcīnāṃ padamicchaṃti vedhasaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-177-1)

There Sāyaṇa explains the word asura as the Supreme Brahman and māyā as the intelligence belonging to the Supreme Brahman. Pataṅga means the Sun. The wise realise, with the heart and a restrained mind, that is, in meditation, the Sun pervaded (aktaḥ) by the intelligence of the Supreme Brahman. Hence here too there is no room for "ignorance". Just as in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā the resolve of Indra and others is designated by the synonym māyā, so the Gītā too follows it; to show this, in the Śrī-bhāṣya, in the Antaradhikaraṇa, the Gītā sentence प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय संभवाम्यात्ममायया (*prakṛtiṃ svāmadhiṣṭhāya* *saṃbhavāmyātmamāyayā*) (Bha. Gī. 4-6) is cited and the word māyā there is explained as intelligence in the form of the Lord's resolve. The Nirukta sentence माया वयुनं, ज्ञानं (*māyā vayunaṃ, jñānaṃ*) is recited there as authority. There is no need to explain here what the exact purport is of the word māyā in the Brahma-sūtra passage माया मात्रं.... (*māyā mātraṃ....*) and the like, nor what the source of the māyā-doctrine is in philosophical procedure, its essential meaning, how this idea grew, or the purport of the contradictory statements.

Besides creative resolve or power, the word is also used in the senses of deceit, fraud, trickery:

त्वं मायाभिरनवद्य मायिनं श्रवस्यता मनसा वृत्रमर्दयः । त्वामिन्नरो वृणते गविष्टषु त्वां विश्वासु हव्यास्विष्टिषु ॥ (*tvaṃ māyābhiranavadya māyinaṃ śravasyatā manasā vṛtramardayaḥ | tvāminnaro vṛṇate gaviṣṭaṣu tvāṃ viśvāsu havyāsviṣṭiṣu ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-147-2)

Here both meanings of the word māyā are shown: the intelligent Indra destroyed the deceitful enemy. Therefore, when used of Indra and the other deities, the word means creative resolve or powerful intelligence; when used of the asuras, it means deceit or fraud. In the present Ṛk too the word is used in the sense of power. Deceitful asuras need extraordinary power to obstruct the guardian and other works of the gods. But the vrata of the gods, protectors of ṛta, is not to be broken by anyone.

Vratā: the word vrata is explained as works such as protecting the world. The meaning of the word is an act performed under a fixed rule. From this point of view, in general the word vrata

is well known as the name for sacrifices and other rites that humans perform for the gods, to please them. Here, however, the word vrata is used for the works of Indra and others; in the present Ṛk the works of the gods are also called vrata. That is, such usages show that, as the performance of sacrifice is necessary for a human from the Vedic point of view, so works such as protecting the world are equally necessary for the gods.

In sentences such as अग्ने व्रतपते व्रतं चरिष्यामि (*agne vratapate vrataṃ cariṣyāmi*) (Śa. Brā. 1-1-1-2) the common relation of gods and humans to vrata is indicated. Vrata can be taken to mean yajña. But if one asks how to say which of the works a human does is yajña and which is not, one must examine a mantra in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā as the answer:

नानानं वा उ नो धियो वि व्रतानि जनानां । तक्षा रिष्टं रुतं भिषग्ब्रह्मा सुन्वंतमिच्छतींद्रायेंदो परि स्रव ॥ (*nānānaṃ vā u no dhiyo vi vratāni janānāṃ | takṣā riṣṭaṃ rutaṃ bhiṣagbrahmā sunvaṃtamicchatīṃdrāyeṃdo pari srava* ||) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-112-1)

In this mantra the many-sided works of humans are described. The vratas of people are many. Among them, the carpenter wishes to do carpentry, the physician to treat disease, the sacrificer to press soma and perform the sacrifice. That is, if each person does the occupation suited to his capacity and nature, with faith and from a sense of duty, then all the works of a human are in the form of vrata; the very life of a human is in the form of vrata. In the same way all the works that the gods do for the maintenance of the world are vrata. As a human performs sacrifices and the like for the gods' satisfaction, the gods too must supply the wealth of help suited to the human's existence and nourishment. This discharge of duty is described here as vrata. As firm as all the vratas observed according to the law of the seasons are the vratas of the gods.

Two explanations of the word vrata are given in the Nirukta: निवृत्तिकर्म वारयतीति सतः (*nivṛttikarma vārayatīti sataḥ*)—since it forbids improper actions, it is called vrata; or since it chooses the duty to be done, it is called vrata (वृणोतीति सतः (*vṛṇotīti sataḥ*) Ni. 2-12). In the explanation वृणोतीति व्रतं (*vṛṇotīti vrataṃ*) the duty that every individual, human or god, must observe regularly is indicated. Third: यदावृणोति शरीरं । तस्मादन्नमपि व्रतमुच्यते (*yadāvṛṇoti śarīraṃ | tasmādannamapi vratamucyate*) (Ni. 2-12). Because it pervades the whole body and gives it strength, food too is called vrata. The word vrata in the present Ṛk can be taken to mean food. The purport is that since the wealth of food supplied by the gods is firm, no one can harm it.

Dhīrāḥ: धीरो धीमान् (*dhīro dhīmān*)—this word is read among the names of the intelligent (Ni. 3-9). In the Vedas and Upaniṣads the word is used in the sense of wise, discriminating. Since the dhīra is wise, and has qualities such as conquering fear and being fearless, remaining calm of mind even in calamity, the purport is "courageous". Citing sentences such as महांतं विभुमात्मानं मत्वा धीरो न शोचति (*mahāṃtaṃ vibhumātmānaṃ matvā dhīro na śocati*) (Kaṭha 5-4)?[137], the distinctive character of this word was explained earlier. Since the wise, discerning person follows the vrata of the gods, there is no violation of this cosmic order. For deceitful asuras it is not possible. Therefore the vratas of the gods are unshakable and eternal. The vrata of Varuṇa, described in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā as dhṛtavrata, is likewise described elsewhere. The nature of these vratas, which cause the world's stability and protection, is this:

अमी य ऋक्षा निहितास उच्चा नक्तं ददृश्रे कुह चिद्दिवेयुः । अदब्धानि वरुणस्य व्रतानि विचाकशच्चंद्रमा नक्तमेति ॥ (*amī ya ṛkṣā nihitāsa uccā naktaṃ dadṛśre kuha ciddiveyuḥ | adabdhāni varuṇasya vratāni vicākaśaccaṃdramā naktameti ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-24-10)

The light of the stars at night and the light of the sun by day are Varuṇa's vratas. The rule of this vrata is unobstructed. Varuṇa's command is the command of the universe; no one can transgress it. Because of this inviolability Mitra and Varuṇa are described as dhṛtavrata (Ni. 8-25-2)?[138]. Likewise:

नहि त्वा शूर देवा न मर्तासो दित्संतं । भीमं न गां वारयंते ॥ (*nahi tvā śūra devā na martāso ditsaṃtaṃ | bhīmaṃ na gāṃ vārayaṃte ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-8-3)

Neither gods nor humans can hinder the great, generous works of Indra. All Indra's works are in the form of vrata; therefore the purport is that they are firm and protect the world.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

षड्भा॒राँ एको॒ अच॑रन्बिभर्त्यृ॒तं वर्षि॑ष्ठ॒मुप॒ गाव॒ आ
गु॑ः ।
ति॒स्रो म॒हीरुप॑रास्तस्थु॒रत्या॒ गुहा॒ द्वे निहि॑ते॒ दर्श्ये
का॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *ṣaḍbhārā~ eko acaranbibhartyṛtaṃ varṣiṣṭhamupa gāva āguḥ |*
> *tisro mahīruparāstasthuratyā guhā dve nihite darśyekā ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> षट् । भारान् । एकः । आचरन् । बिभर्ति । यतम् । वर्षिष्ठं । उप । गावः । आ
> अगुः ।

> *ṣaṭ | bhārān | ekaḥ | ācaran | bibharti | yatam | varṣiṣṭhaṃ | upa |*
> *gāvaḥ | ā*
> *aguḥ |*

> तिस्रः । महीः । उपराः । तस्थुः । अत्याः। गुहा । द्वे इति । निहिते इति निहिते । दर्शि ।
> एका ॥ २ ॥

> *tisraḥ | mahīḥ | uparāḥ | tasthuḥ | atyāḥ| guhā | dve iti | nihite iti*
> *nihite | darśi |*
> *ekā ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अचरन् स्थायी एकः संवत्सरः षट् षट् संख्याकान् भारान् । भ्रियते पुष्पनिकासादि येष्विति
> भारा ऋतवः । तान्यसंतादीन् बिभर्ति । अवयवत्वेन धारयति ।
> तथा ऋतं सत्यभूतं वर्षिष्टं वृद्धतरमादित्यात्मकं तमेव संवत्सरं गावो रश्मय
> उपागुः ! प्राप्नुवंति । किंच तस्मिन्नेव संवत्सरेऽत्या आतनशीला आगमापायिधर्मोपेतास्तिस्रो
> महीस्त्रयो लोका उपरा उपर्युपरि वर्तमानास्तस्थुः । तिष्ठंति ।
> लोकत्रयमेव दर्शयति । गुहा गुहायां स्वात्मनि द्वे द्यौश्चांतरिक्षं चेत्येते
> निहिते । न दृश्येते । एका भूमिदर्शि । सर्वभूताधारतया दृश्यते ॥ भारान् ।

> डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यसा दधिकरणे घञ् । कर्षात्वतो घञ् इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं । निहिते ।
> दधातेः कर्मणि निष्ठा । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं । दर्शि ।
> दृशिर् प्रेक्षणे । कर्मणि लुङ् चिणि चिणो लुगिति प्रत्ययस्य लुक् । वाक्यभेदादनिघातः ॥

> *acaran sthāyī ekaḥ saṃvatsaraḥ ṣaṭ ṣaṭ saṃkhyākān bhārān | bhriyate puṣpanikāsādi yeṣṭiti bhārā ṛtavaḥ | tānyasaṃtādīn bibharti | avayavatvena dhārayati |*
> *tathā ṛtaṃ satyabhūtaṃ varṣiṣṭaṃ vṛddhataramādityātmakaṃ tameva saṃvatsaraṃ gāvo raśmaya*
> *upāguḥ ! prāpruvaṃti | kiṃca tasminneva saṃvatsare 'tyā ātanaśīlā āgamāpāyidharmopetāstisro mahīstrayo lokā uparā uparyupari vartamānāstasthuḥ | tiṣṭhaṃti |*
> *lokatrayameva darśayati | guhā guhāyāṃ svātmani dve dyauścāṃtarikṣaṃ cetyete*
> *nihite | na dṛśyete | ekā bhūmidarśi | sarvabhūtādhāratayā dṛśyate ‖ bhārān |*
> *ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasā dadhikaraṇe ghañ | karṣātvato ghañ ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | nihite | dadhāteḥ karmaṇi niṣṭhā | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ | darśi |*
> *dṛśir prekṣaṇe | karmaṇi luṅ ciṇi ciṇo lugiti pratyayasya luk | vākyabhedādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Acaran, the one stationary year, bears six burdens (bhārāḥ); the seasons are called bhāras because from them flowers, shoots and the like are borne. It holds spring and the others as its parts. Likewise the rays (gāvaḥ) reach that same year, which is ṛta, true, the most extensive, of the nature of the Sun. Further, in that same year the three great worlds (mahīḥ), moving, subject to coming and going, stand one above another. He shows the three worlds: of these, two, heaven and atmosphere, are hidden in a cave, in the year's own self, not seen; one, the earth, is seen, since it is seen as the support of all beings.

Word-to-word meaning

- अचरन् (*acaran*)—remaining stationary, without movement
- एकः (*ekaḥ*)—the one principle in the form of the year

- षट् भारान् (*ṣaṭ bhārān*)—the six burdens in the form of seasons
- बिभर्ति (*bibharti*)—bears
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—that which is of the nature of truth
- वर्षिष्ठं (*varṣiṣṭhaṃ*)—the Āditya-principle, eldest of all
- गावः (*gāvaḥ*)—rays
- उप आगुः (*upa āguḥ*)—attach themselves
- अत्याः (*atyāḥ*)—moving
- तिस्रो महीः (*tisro mahīḥ*)—the three worlds also
- उपराः (*uparāḥ*)—one above another
- तस्थुः (*tasthuḥ*)—are established
- द्वे (*dve*)—(of them) both heaven and atmosphere
- गुहा (*guhā*)—in a hidden, imperceptible region
- निहिते (*nihite*)—are placed
- एका (*ekā*)—the other, the earth
- दर्शि (*darśi*)—is visible (to all)

Gist

The principle in the form of the year, remaining stationary without movement, bears the six burdens in the form of the seasons. The rays join the Āditya, who is of the nature of truth and the best of all. The three moving worlds are established one above another. Of them, heaven and atmosphere are placed in a hidden, imperceptible region. The other, the earth, is visible to all.

English translation

One stationary (year) sustains six burthens (in the seasons); the (solar) rays spread through that true and extensive (term); three revolving spheres are severally above, two of which are placed in secret, and one is visible.

Special Topics

This mantra describes the nature of the Āditya-principle, itself unmoving and the basis of all movements of the universe. By showing the identity of the year and Āditya, it also indicates the common nature of the seasons, parts of the year, and the rays, parts of Āditya. Or, since it says षट् भारान् बिभर्ति (*ṣaṭ bhārān bibharti*), "bears six burdens in the form of seasons", the seasons are said to be parts of Āditya; that is, one may say that it shows non-difference between Āditya and the year. Showing their non-difference, both teach the Prajāpati-principle. One may also say that the nature of Āditya is the nature of the year, and the nature of the year is the nature of Prajāpati. There are many authorities for this.

त्रीणि च वै शतानि षष्टिश्च संवत्सरस्याहानि तावान्तंवत्सरः संवत्सरः प्रजापतिः .... यं प्रजायमानं विश्वं रूपमिदमनुप्रजायते ॥ (*trīṇi ca vai śatāni ṣaṣṭiśca saṃvatsarasyāhāni tāvāntaṃvatsaraḥ saṃvatsaraḥ prajāpatiḥ .... yaṃ prajāyamānaṃ viśvaṃ rūpamidamanuprajāyate ‖*) (Ai. Brā. 2-17)

The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa says that the year, with three hundred and sixty days, twelve months and six seasons, is Prajāpati.

कालात्स्रवंति भूतानि कालाद्वृद्धिं प्रयांति च । काले चास्तं नियच्छंति कालो मूर्तिरमूर्तिमान् ॥ (*kālātsravaṃti bhūtāni kālādvṛddhiṃ prayāṃti ca | kāle cāstaṃ niyacchaṃti kālo mūrtiramūrtimān ‖*) (Mai. U. 6-14)

Brahman, in the form of Āditya, has two forms: the first is time, the second is non-time. The root-reality of the Āditya-principle is timeless and without kalā. The whole universe produced from Āditya is kalā-natured. From this arises the birth of creatures. Therefore the year, which is of the nature of time and of kalā, is Prajāpati; such is the explanation of the Maitrī Upaniṣad. This very idea is in the present Ṛk, अचरन् एकः षड्भारान् बिभर्ति (*acaran ekaḥ ṣaḍbhārān bibharti*): the root-reality itself not moving, makes the whole universe produced from it move, and itself holds that whole moving universe.

चतुर्भिः साकं नवतिं च नामभिश्चक्रंन वृत्तं व्यतीरवीविपत् । (*caturbhiḥ sākaṃ navatiṃ ca nāmabhiścakraṃ na vṛttaṃ vyatīravīvipat |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-155-6)

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रि॒पा॒ज॒स्यो वृ॑ष॒भो वि॒श्वरू॑प उ॒त त्र्यु॒धा पु॑रु॒ध प्र॒जावा॑न् ।
त्र्य॒नी॒कः प॑त्यते॒ माहि॑नावा॒न्स रे॑तो॒धा वृ॑ष॒भः शश्व॑तीनाम् ॥ ३ ॥

> *tripājasyo vṛṣabho viśvarūpa uta tryudhā purudha prajāvān |*
> *tryanīkaḥ patyate māhināvānsa retodhā vṛṣabhaḥ śaśvatīnām ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रिपाज स्यः । वृषभः । विश्वरूपः । उत । त्रिउधा । पुरुध । प्रजावान् ।
> त्रिअनीकः । पत्यते । माहिनवान् । सः । रेतोधाः । वृषभः । शश्वतीनां ॥ ३ ॥

> *tripāja syaḥ | vṛṣabhaḥ | viśvarūpaḥ | uta | triudhā | purudha | prajāvān |*
> *trianīkaḥ | patyate | māhinavān | saḥ | retodhāḥ | vṛṣabhaḥ | śaśvatīnāṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> त्रिपाजस्यः ग्रीष्मवर्षाहिमंताख्यैस्त्रिभिर्यतुभिः पाजस्यमुरो यस्य स त्रिपाजस्यः । त्रुरस्क इत्यर्थः । उरोवचनश्च पाजस्यशब्दः । इंद्रस्य क्रोडोऽदित्यै पाजस्यं । वाज. २५–८ । इत्यश्वमेधमंत्र उरःपरतयाम्ना नात् पाजसि बले साधुरिति व्युत्पत्तेश्च सर्वेषामंगानां मध्य उरसो बलवत्वात् । वृषभः स्वावयभूते वर्षर्तावसां वर्षको विश्वरूपस्तत्तद्वृत्तसाधारणकार्यैः पुष्पविकासादिभिर्लिंगैर्नानारूप उतापि च त्रुधा । वसंतशरद्धेमंताख्यैस्त्रिभिर्यतुभिरूधो यस्य स त्रुधा । प्रजावान' । प्रकर्षण जायंत इति व्रीह्यादयः प्रजाः । पुरुष नानाप्रकारेण विद्यमानव्रीहियवादिरूपप्रजावान् । किंच त्र्यनीकस्त्रिभिरुष्णवर्षशीता–

> *tripājasyaḥ grīṣmavarṣāhemaṃtākhyaistribhiryatubhiḥ pājasyamuro yasya sa*
> *tripājasyaḥ | truraska ityarthaḥ | urovacanaśca pājasyaśabdaḥ |*
> *iṃdrasya kroḍo 'dityai*

> *pājasyaṃ | vāja. 25-8 | ityaśvamedhamaṃtra uraḥparatayāmnā nāt*
> *pājasi bale sādhuriti vyutpatteśca sarveṣāmaṃgānāṃ madhya uraso*
> *balavatvāt | vṛṣabhaḥ svāvayabhūte*
> *varṣartāvasāṃ varṣako viśvarūpastattadvṛttasādhāraṇakāryaiḥ*
> *puṣpavikāsādibhirliṃgairnānārūpa utāpi ca trudhā |*
> *vasaṃtaśaraddhemaṃtākhyaistribhiryatubhirūdho yasya sa*
> *trudhā | prajāvāna ' | prakarṣaṇa jāyaṃta iti vrīhyādayaḥ prajāḥ |*
> *puruṣa nānāprakāreṇa vidyamānavrīhiyavādirūpaprajāvān | kiṃca*
> *tryanīkastribhiruṣṇavarṣaśītā-*

> खैरनीकैर्गुणैरुपेतो माहिनावान्महत्त्ववान् संवत्सराभिमानी देवः पत्यते ।
> आगच्छति । वृषभः सेचनसमर्थः स संवत्सरः शश्वतीनां बह्नीनामोषधीनां पुष्पफलादिसंपत्तये
> रेतोधा रेतस उदकस्य धर्ता भवति ॥ त्र्युधा । बहुव्रीहेरूधसोऽनञ्जित्यनज् । सर्वविधीनां
> छंदसि विकल्पितत्वात्पुंस्यपि भवति । ऊकारस्य ह्रस्वश्छांधसः । उत्तरपदांतोदात्तप्रकरणे
> त्रिचक्रादीनां छंदस्युपसंख्यानमित्युत्तर
> पदांतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *khairanīkairguṇairupeto māhināvānmahattvavān saṃvatsarābhimānī*
> *devaḥ patyate |*
> *āgacchati | vṛṣabhaḥ secanasamarthaḥ sa saṃvatsaraḥ śaśvatīnāṃ*
> *bahnīnāmoṣadhīnāṃ puṣpaphalādisaṃpattaye retodhā retasa udakasya*
> *dhartā bhavati ‖ tryudhā | bahuvrīherūdhaso 'najjityanaj |*
> *sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi vikalpitatvātpuṃsyapi bhavati | ūkārasya*
> *hrasvaśchāṃdhasaḥ | uttarapadāṃtodāttaprakaraṇe tricakrādīnāṃ*
> *chaṃdasyupasaṃkhyānamityuttara*
> *padāṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*): he whose chest (*pājasya*) is formed by three seasons named Grīṣma, Varṣā and Hemanta; that is, "three-chested". The word *pājasya* denotes the chest; in the Aśvamedha mantra इंद्रस्य क्रोडोऽदित्यै पाजस्यं (*iṃdrasya kroḍo 'dityai pājasyaṃ*) (Vāj. 25-8) it is read as meaning the chest; and by derivation it is what is good in strength, since among all the limbs the chest is the strongest. वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*): the showerer, who rains in the rainy season, its own part. विश्वरूपः (*viśvarūpaḥ*): of many forms, by the signs, the effects common to each season, such as the blossoming of flowers. उत (*uta*): and also त्रुधा (*trudhā*): he whose udder is formed by the three seasons named

Vasanta, Śarad and Hemanta. प्रजावान् (*prajāvān*): *prajāḥ* are rice and the like, which are born forth; *puruṣa* (*purudha*): possessing progeny in the form of rice, barley and the rest, existing in many kinds. Further, त्र्यनीकः (*tryanīkaḥ*): he who is endowed with three hosts (*anīka*), the qualities of heat, rain and cold, …

… माहिनावान् (*māhināvān*): possessing greatness; the deity presiding over the year पत्यते (*patyate*): comes. वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*): able to sprinkle; that year शश्वतीनां (*śaśvatīnāṃ*): of the many plants, for the attainment of flowers, fruits and the like, becomes रेतोधा (*retodhā*): the bearer of *retas*, water.

Word-to-word meaning

- त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*)—having three chests named Grīṣma, Varṣā and Hemanta
- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—that which pours down rain
- विश्वरूपः (*viśvarūpaḥ*)—that which takes on various forms according to the differences of the seasons
- उत (*uta*)—and
- त्र्युधा (*tryudhā*)—having three *ūdhaḥ* (udder) regions in the forms of Vasanta, Śarad and Hemanta
- पुरुध प्रजावान् (*purudha prajāvān*)—having progeny of many kinds, in the form of rice and the like
- त्यनीकः (*tyanīkaḥ*)—endowed with three qualities, in the forms of heat, rain and cold
- माहिनावान् (*māhināvān*)—having a great nature; the deity presiding over the year
- पत्यते (*patyate*)—comes
- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—the fulfiller of desires by rain
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same deity presiding over the year
- शश्वतीनां (*śaśvatīnāṃ*)—to the many plants and the like
- रेतोधाः (*retodhāḥ*)—the one who fills them with water

Gist

The deity presiding over the year, having three chest regions beginning with Grīṣma, bestowing rain, having many forms according to the differences of the seasons, having three udder regions in the forms of Vasanta and the rest, having many kinds of progeny in the form of rice and the like, endowed with the three qualities beginning with heat, and of great nature, comes. That same deity presiding over the year, the fulfiller of desires by rain, fills the many plants and the like with water.

English translation

The three-breasted, the showerer (of rain), the omniform, the three-uddered, the parent of multiform progeny, the possessor of magnitude, followed by three hosts (the year), advances, the vigorous impregnator of the perpetual plants-

Special Topics

In the previous mantra the principle of the year is described by षड्भारान् एको आचरन् बिभर्ति (*ṣaḍbhārān eko ācaran bibharti*). *Ṣaḍbhāra* means the six seasons. The year itself, which bears such a burden of six and, holding the three worlds under its control, carries on the business of the universe, may be called a manifestation (*vibhūti*) of Āditya. The nature of the parts of the year, this manifestation of Āditya, and their influence are described in the present Ṛk.

The parts of this year, which is of the form of the seasons, are compared to the chest region and to the udder region. The chest region indicates strength, and the udder region indicates the giving of abundant food. Therefore, among the parts of the year, three set forth strength and the other three the bestowing of wealth.

त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*)—The word *pājasya* is taken to mean the chest region; the purport is "having a threefold chest region". The authors of the Nirukta have read the word *pājas* among the names of strength (Ni. 2-9). Therefore, realising that taking *pājas* to mean "strength" in accordance with the Nirukta would not fit, Sāyaṇa upheld his own meaning *uras*, quoted the Vājasaneyi-Saṃhitā passage इंद्रस्य क्रीडोऽदित्यै पाजस्यं (*iṃdrasya krīḍo 'dityai pājasyaṃ*), and stated that, as the word *pājasya* there is a synonym of the word *uras*, the meaning should be given in the same way in the present passage. In places such as अरेजेतां रोदसी पाजसा गिरा (*arejetāṃ rodasī pājasā girā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-151-1) the meaning "endowed with strength" was given earlier. In the Ṛksaṃhitā this word is used in three senses. After noting that context, one should then examine what its purport is in the present passage.

विद्युद्रथः सहसस्पुत्रो अग्निः शोचिष्केश् पृथिव्यां पाजो आश्रेत् । (*vidyudrathaḥ sahasasputro agniḥ śociṣkeś pṛthivyāṃ pājo āśret* |)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-14-1)

One meaning is that Agni, whose vehicle is lightning and who is full of strength, obtained brightness in the atmosphere and shone; another meaning is that he obtained strength on the earth. According to the description here, the purport may be stated as: he pervaded the atmosphere or the earth and became radiant. In अरुषस्तूपो रुशदस्य पाजः (*aruṣastūpo ruśadasya pājaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-29-3), since it is said that Agni destroyed the darkness and spread his own radiance, the word *pājas* must be given the meaning "brilliance". Likewise in contexts such as ऊर्ध्वं मधुधा दिवि पाज : (*ūrdhvaṃ madhudhā divi pāja :*) (3-61-5) and कृणुष्व पाजः प्रसितिं न (*kṛṇuṣva pājaḥ prasitiṃ na*) (4-4-1) the meaning is a mass of brilliance. But

पाजस्वंतो न वीराः पनस्यवो रिशादसो न मर्या अभिद्यवः । (*pājasvaṃto na vīrāḥ panasyavo riśādaso na maryā abhidyavaḥ* |)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-27-3)

in places such as this, since it is of heroes that the passage speaks, the meaning must be given with certainty as "strength" in all of them. The qualified word त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*) is used in the Ṛksaṃhitā only in the present Ṛk. Here the word *pājasya* is taken to mean *uras*, "chest". Or it could be the flank. There is room too for doubt whether it is the belly (*jaṭhara*) or the *kukṣi*. This is an epithet of the year-deity...

...Therefore, in order to decide whether it is right to say "having threefold strength", or "having a threefold belly", or "having three kinds of flank", one must understand in what manner the epithets त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*), त्र्युधा (*tryudhā*), त्र्यनीकः (*tryanīkaḥ*) and the like describe the nature of the divisions of the year.

The epithets त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*) and त्र्युधा (*tryudhā*) indicate the six divisions of the year; त्रैनीकः (*trainīkaḥ*) indicates the three qualities of the year. According to the divisions now in use these three qualities fit in order. But it must be examined whether the division of the seasons in the Ṛksaṃhitā is as it is now in use, or whether the divisions there differ from the present reckoning.

For the epithet त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*) Sāyaṇa has explained that the divisions named Grīṣma, Varṣā and Hemanta are the chest region of the year. If the doubt arises whether the meaning "chest" or the meaning "strength" is right for the word *pājasya*, he has also stated that there is no impropriety in giving this meaning, since the chest is the strongest of all the limbs. And for the word त्र्युधा (*tryudhā*) he has explained that the three divisions Vasanta, Śarad and Hemanta are like the udder region of the year. In the present context one must see whether these divisions of the year are stated in the same way everywhere, or whether the number of the seasons differs from one place to another.

Grīṣma, Varṣā, Hemanta is one division;

Vasanta, Śarad, Hemanta is another division.

Here Hemanta is common to both. There is no separate division called the Śiśira season; it should be understood as included in Hemanta. Therefore, whether the number of seasons is five or six cannot be stated as "this and thus". There are many differences in this division. The number of the seasons is stated as three in some places, as five in others, as six in some passages and as seven in one or two contexts. But these reckonings cannot be said to contradict one another. In places such as यजाता यतुभिध्रुवेभिः (*yajātā yatubhidhrruvebhiḥ*) (1-84-18)[?148] there is no reckoning of number but merely a mention of the seasons, yet the epithet *dhruvebhiḥ* tells us the nature of the season. But in some other places there is no distinction by names of the seasons; the number of the seasons must be known from the number alone. For example:

त्रिनाभि चक्रमजरमनर्वं यत्रेमा विश्वा भुवनाधि तस्थुः । (*trinābhi cakramajaramanarvaṃ yatremā viśvā bhuvanādhi tasthuḥ* |)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-2)

In the phrase त्रिनाभि चक्रं(*trinābhi cakraṃ*) the word *trinābhi* ("three-naved") points to the parts of the year. Explaining this passage, the Nirukta-writers say:

संवत्सरप्रधान उत्तरोर्धर्चस्त्रिनाभिचक्रं त्रैशितुः संवत्सरो ग्रीष्मो वर्षा हेमंत इति ॥ (*saṃvatsarapradhāna uttarordharcastrināḅhicakraṃ traiśituḥ saṃvatsaro grīṣmo varṣā hemaṃta iti* ||) (Ni. 4-26).

This year consists of three naves. The naves are the Grīṣma (summer) season, the Varṣā (rainy) season and the Hemanta (winter) season. This year, made of three seasons, is described as त्रिनाभिचक्रं (*trinābhicakraṃ*). The meaning is that Āditya (the sun) turns by repetition the wheel of the year, which has these parts, which like a wheel goes round again and again, and which is ageless and without a rival (*anarva*). Supporting this very meaning, the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa says:

तिस्रो रात्रिर्व्रतं चरति (*tisro rātrirvrataṃ carati*) त्रयो वा ऋतवः संवत्सरस्य .... (*trayo vā ṛtavaḥ saṃvatsarasya ....*) (Śa. Brā. 14-1-1-28).

This rule is that there are to be three nights. Since the year has three seasons, the rule must follow this number. This year is Āditya. In such places only the number three is stated, yet in the Ṛksaṃhitā the names themselves are expressly stated:

यत्पुरुषेण हविषा देवा यज्ञमतन्वत । वसंतो अस्यासीदाज्यं ग्रीष्म इध्मश्वरद्धविः ॥ (*yatpuruṣeṇa haviṣā devā yajñamatanvata* | *vasaṃto asyāsīdājyaṃ grīṣma idhmaśvaradbhaviḥ* ||) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-90-6).

This sacrifice, which has the form of the Puruṣa, reflects the principle of the year. For it, spring is the ghee, summer the fuel, and autumn the oblation: thus the names of three seasons are given. But in the sentence पंचपादं पितरं द्वादशाकृतिं (*paṃcapādaṃ pitaraṃ* *dvādaśākṛtiṃ*) (1-164-12), "five-footed" means five seasons. एतत् हेमंतशिशिरयोः एकत्राभिप्रायं (*etat hemaṃtaśiśirayoḥ ekatrābhiprāyaṃ*)[?149]. There is no separate Śiśira; Hemanta and Śiśira together make one. Hence the number five is in order. In contrast, in sentences such as साकंजानां सप्तथमाहुरेकजं (*sākaṃjānāṃ saptathamāhurekajaṃ*) (1-164-15) seven seasons are indicated; here the Śiśira season has a place of its own. Moreover: चैत्रादीनां द्वादशानां मासानां द्वयमेलनेन वसंताद्याः षड्रृतवो भवंति । अधिकमासेन एकः उत्पद्यते सप्तमर्तुः । (*caitrādīnāṃ dvādaśānāṃ māsānāṃ dvayamelanena vasaṃtādyāḥ ṣaḍṛtavo bhavaṃti | adhikamāsena ekaḥ utpadyate saptamartuḥ |*). Caitra and Vaiśākha together make one season; thus one season for each pair of months, and another season for the intercalary month. So there are six for twelve months, and a seventh season for the thirteenth month; this too is so. To call Hemanta and Śiśira together by the single name Hemanta-Śiśira is customary in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā and similar works.

वसंतमृतूनां प्रीणामि स मा प्रीतः प्रीणातु ग्रीष्ममृतूनां प्रीणामि स मा प्रीतः प्रीणातु । वर्षाऋतूनां प्रीणामि ता मा प्रीताः प्रीणंतु । शरदमृतूनां प्रीणामि सा मा प्रीता प्रिणातु । हेमंतशिशिरावृतूनां प्रीणामि तौ मा प्रित्वा प्रीणीतां ॥ (*vasaṃtamṛtūnāṃ prīṇāmi sa mā prītaḥ prīṇātu grīṣmamṛtūnāṃ prīṇāmi sa mā prītaḥ prīṇātu | varṣāṛtūnāṃ prīṇāmi tā mā prītāḥ prīṇaṃtu | śaradamṛtūnāṃ prīṇāmi sā mā prītā priṇātu | hemaṃtaśiśirāvṛtūnāṃ prīṇāmi tau mā pritvā prīṇītāṃ ‖*) (Śai. Saṃ. 1-6-2).[?150]

I satisfy the spring season; may it, satisfied, gladden me. I satisfy the summer season; may it, satisfied, satisfy me. I nourish the rainy season; may it, nourished, gladden me. I satisfy the autumn season; may it, satisfied, satisfy me. I satisfy the Hemanta-Śiśira seasons; may they, satisfied, satisfy me. Thus the number of the seasons is stated, and it is expressly given as five. Supporting this, पंचोपदधाति । पंच वा ऋतवः (*paṃcopadadhāti | paṃca vā ṛtavaḥ*): here a definite count of five is made. Likewise, in sentences such as ग्रीष्मो हेमंत उत नो वसंतश्वरद्वर्षास्सुवितं नो अस्तु (*grīṣmo hemaṃta uta no vasaṃtaśvaradvarṣāssuvitaṃ no astu*), five seasons without Śiśira are stated in many places. This number agrees with the number in the Ṛksaṃhitā sentence पंचारे चक्रे (*paṃcāre cakre*).

In the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa, when the nature of Āditya is described, the seasons are given as his limbs in this way:

संवत्थरोऽसि परिवत्थरोऽसि । इदावत्सरोऽसि दुवत्सरोऽसि । इद्वत्सरोऽसि वत्सरोऽसि तस्य ते वसंतश्शिरः । ग्रीष्मो दक्षिणः पक्षः । वर्षाः पुच्छं । शरदुत्तरः पक्षः । हेमंतो मध्यं । (*saṃvattharo 'si parivattharo 'si | idāvatsaro 'si duvatsaro 'si | idvatsaro 'si vatsaro 'si tasya te vasaṃtaśśiraḥ | grīṣmo dakṣiṇaḥ pakṣaḥ | varṣāḥ pucchaṃ | śaraduttaraḥ pakṣaḥ | hemaṃto madhyaṃ |*) (Tai. Brā. 3-10-4-1).

For this Āditya the Grīṣma season is the right wing, the rainy season the tail, the autumn season the left wing, Hemanta the middle, and spring, the foremost of all, the head: so the description is both material and spiritual. Here too Śiśira is included within Hemanta.

But in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa there is a difference of another kind. Here the description of the form of the sacrificial Self is made up of limbs that are seasons. Instead of joining the Hemanta and Śiśira seasons as elsewhere, it joins the rainy season and autumn together as वर्षाशरदावृतू (*varṣāśaradāvṛtū*). There are also places where Hemanta and Śiśira are divided and the names of six seasons are stated together: षड्भिः पचति । षड्वा ऋतवः । ऋतुभिरेवैनां पचति (*ṣaḍbhiḥ pacati | ṣaḍvā ṛtavaḥ | ṛtubhirevaināṃ pacati*) (Tai. Saṃ. 5-1-7-2) and similar passages state "six" plainly.

When the division is made into six in this way, the description of the present Ṛk is that the first three seasons show one power of the year and the other three another power. Among them, Grīṣma, Varṣā and Hemanta are described as *tripājasya*, and Vasanta, Śarad and Hemanta as *tryudhā*. It was thus said that in these seasons brightness and strength, these two qualities, belong first to the group of three, while the bestowing of wealth and wholesome things belongs to the second group of three. But the power of the seasons is reckoned in one way in one place and in another way elsewhere. For example, the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa says that the Prayāja sacrifice, the root of all victory, is the essence of the principle of the seasons. In the Prayāja sacrifice the five, Samidh, Tanūnapāt, Iḍa, Barhi and Svāhā, are the chief principles. These five exert their influence on the five seasons in order, and in accordance with that influence the five seasons become fruitful to the sacrificer. This is described in the present Ṛk by *retodhāḥ*.

ऋतवो ह वै प्रयाजाः । तस्मात्पंच भवंति पंच ह्रतवः । देवाश्च वा असुराश्च । उभये प्राजापत्याः पस्प धिर एतस्मिन् यज्ञे प्रजापत् पितरि संवत्सरेऽस्माकमयं भविष्यत्यस्माकमयं भविष्यतीति । (*ṛtavo ha vai prayājāḥ | tasmātpaṃca bhavaṃti paṃca hṛtavaḥ | devāśca vā asurāśca | ubhaye prājāpatyāḥ paspa dhira etasmin yajñe prajāpat pitari saṃvatsare 'smākamayaṃ bhaviṣyatyasmākamayaṃ bhaviṣyatīti |*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-1, 2).

The year is the principle of Prajāpati. The gods and the asuras, both born of Prajāpati, fell into doubt about their father Prajāpati, who is the year, and quarrelled. The gods insisted that it belonged to them, the asuras that it belonged to them.

ततो देवाः । अर्चंतः श्राम्यंतश्चेरुस्त एतान् प्रयाजान् ददृशुस्त्यैरयजंत तैर्यतून् संवत्सरं प्राजयन्नृतुभ्यः संवत्सरात्सपत्नान् .... तस्मात्संवत्सरात्सपत्नानंतरेति ॥ (*tato devāḥ | arcaṃtaḥ śrāmyaṃtaścerusta etān prayājān dadṛśustyairayajaṃta tairyatūn saṃvatsaraṃ prājayannṛtubhyaḥ saṃvatsarātsapatnān .... tasmātsaṃvatsarātsapatnānaṃtareti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-3).

Then the gods, worshipping and practising austerity, propitiated the deity presiding over the year. They saw the Prayāja and with its help made their worship. Then they won over the seasons and the year.

स आश्राव्याह । समिधो यजेति तद्वसंतग्ं समिंधे । स वसंतः समिद्धोऽन्यानृतून् समिंध ऋतवः समिद्धाः प्रजाश्च प्रजनयंत्योषधीश्च पचंति । (*sa āśrāvyāha | samidho yajeti tadvasaṃtagṃ samiṃdhe | sa vasaṃtaḥ samiddho 'nyānṛtūn samiṃdha ṛtavaḥ samiddhāḥ prajāśca prajanayaṃtyoṣadhīśca pacaṃti |*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-8).

Then the Adhvaryu says to the Hotṛ, "Recite the yājyā mantra to the fuel-sticks." Then spring is kindled. The kindled spring brings forth the other seasons too. All the other seasons, kindled, cause the birth of creatures and make the plants bear fruit.

स वै समिधो यजति । वसंतो वै समिद्वसंतमेव तद्देवा अवृंजत वसंतात्सपत्नानंतरायन् .... वसंतात्सपत्नानंतरेति । (*sa vai samidho yajati | vasaṃto vai samidvasaṃtameva taddevā avṛṃjata vasaṃtātsapatnānaṃtarāyan .... vasaṃtātsapatnānaṃtareti* |) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-9).[?151]

Then he recites the yājyā mantra to the fuel-sticks. The presiding deity of this fuel is spring itself. On this occasion the gods won over spring and destroyed the enemies of spring. Therefore spring is a bringer of victory.

अथ तनूनपातं यजति । ग्रीष्मो वै तनूनपात् ग्रीष्मो ह्यासां प्रजानां तनूस्तपति ग्रीष्ठमेव तद्देवा अवृंजत ग्रीष्मात्सपत्नानंतरायन् ॥ (*atha tanūnapātaṃ yajati | grīṣmo vai tanūnapāt grīṣmo hyāsāṃ prajānāṃ tanūstapati grīṣṭhameva taddevā avṛṃjata grīṣmātsapatnānaṃtarāyan ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-10).

Then he recites the yājyā to the deity Tanūnapāt. The gods won over Grīṣma, which burns enemies, by this mantra and by worship, and made it so that the fruit of Grīṣma did not reach their enemies.

अथेडो यजति । वर्षा वा इड इति हि वर्षा इडो यदिदं क्षुद्रगं्सरीसृपं ग्रीष्महेमंताभ्यां नित्यक्तं भवति तद्वर्षा ईडितमिवान्नमिच्छमानं चरति....॥ (*atheḍo yajati | varṣā vā iḍa iti hi varṣā iḍo yadidaṃ kṣudragṃsarīsṛpaṃ grīṣmahemaṃtābhyāṃ nityaktaṃ bhavati tadvarṣā īḍitamivānnamicchamānaṃ carati....‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-3-11).

Then, at the time of reciting the yājyā to Iḍa, the gods won over the rainy season. Creatures troubled in the summer and in the Hemanta season regain vitality again in this season, and they announce rain.

In the same way, when the mantra is recited to Barhi, they won over the deity presiding over autumn. All the plants that were struck down in Grīṣma and Hemanta regain vitality in this season. When the recitation is made to the deity Svāhā, they made present to themselves Hemanta, the end of the year. They made it so that the final benefit of the year did not fall to the asuras. These seasons, which accomplished the desired aims of the gods, grant desired aims to man also. This very point is stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā in sentences such as "he recites to the fuel-sticks; he wins spring among the seasons":

समिधो यजति वसंतमेवर्तूनामवरुंधे तनूनपातं यजति ग्रीष्ममेवावरुंध इडो यजति वर्षा एवावरुंधे बर्हिर्यजति शरदमेवावरुंधे (*samidho yajati vasaṃtamevartūnāmavaruṃdhe tanūnapātaṃ yajati grīṣmamevāvaruṃdha iḍo yajati varṣā evāvaruṃdhe barhiryajati śaradamevāvaruṃdhe*)

स्वाहाकारं यजति हेमंतमेवावरुंधे तस्मात्साहाकृता हेमन् पशवोऽव सीदंति समिधो यजत्युषस एव देवतानामवरुंधे तनूनपातं यजति यज्ञमेवावरुंधे इडो यजति पशूनेवावरुंधे बर्हिर्यजति प्रजामेवावरुंध समानयत उपभृतस्तेजो वा आज्यं प्रजा बर्हिः प्रजास्वेव तेजो दधाति स्वाहाकारं यजति वाचमेवावरुंदे ॥ (*svāhākāraṃ yajati hemaṃtamevāvaruṃdhe tasmātsāhākṛtā heman paśavo 'va sīdaṃti samidho yajatyuṣasa eva devatānāmavaruṃdhe tanūnapātaṃ yajati yajñamevāvaruṃdhe iḍo yajati paśūnevāvaruṃdhe barhiryajati prajāmevāvaruṃdha samānayata upabhṛtastejo vā ājyaṃ prajā barhiḥ prajāsveva tejo dadhāti svāhākāraṃ yajati vācamevāvaruṃde* ‖) (Tai. Saṃ. 2-6-1-1, 2).[?152]

Besides this, the seasons have natural powers that also indicate the duties of the castes and stages of life.

ब्रह्मैव वसंतः । क्षत्रं ग्रीष्मो विडेव वर्षास्तस्माद्ब्राह्मणो वसंत आदधीत ब्रह्म हि वसंतस्तस्मात् क्षत्रियो ग्रीष्म आदधीत क्षत्रगं् हि ग्रीष्मस्त स्माद्वैश्यो वर्षास्वादधीत विड्डि वर्षाः (*brahmaiva vasaṃtaḥ | kṣatraṃ grīṣmo viḍeva varṣāstasmādbrāhmaṇo vasaṃta ādadhīta brahma hi vasaṃtastasmāt kṣatriyo grīṣma ādadhīta kṣatragṃ hi grīṣmasta smādvaiśyo varṣāsvādadhīta viḍḍi varṣāḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 2-1-3-5).

Spring is of the nature of Brahman. Therefore a Brāhmaṇa should establish the fire in spring. Grīṣma is of the nature of the Kṣatra; therefore a Kṣatriya should do so in the Grīṣma season; and since the rainy season is of the nature of the Vaiśya, a Vaiśya should perform it in the rainy season.

वसंता ब्राह्मणोऽग्निमादधीत । वसंतो वैब्राह्मणस्यर्तुः । स्व एवैनमृतावाधाय । ब्रह्मवर्चसी भवति । मुखं ना एतदृतूनां । यद्वसंतः । यो वसंताग्निमाधत्ते । मुख्य एव भवति । ग्रीष्मो वै राजन्यस्यर्तुः । स्व एवैनमृतावाधाय । इंद्रियावी भवति । शरदि वैश्य आदधीत । शरद्वै वैश्यस्यर्तुः । स्व एवैनमृतावाधाय । पशुमान् भवति । (*vasaṃtā brāhmaṇo 'gnimādadhīta | vasaṃto vaibrāhmaṇasyartuḥ | sva evainamṛtāvādhāya | brahmavarcasī bhavati | mukhaṃ nā etadṛtūnāṃ | yadvasaṃtaḥ | yo vasaṃtāgnimādhatte | mukhya* *eva bhavati | grīṣmo vai rājanyasyartuḥ | sva evainamṛtāvādhāya | iṃdriyāvī bhavati | śaradi vaiśya ādadhīta | śaradvai vaiśyasyartuḥ | sva evainamṛtāvādhāya | paśumān bhavati |*) (Tai. Brā. 1-1-2-6, 7).

A Brāhmaṇa should perform the sacrifice in the spring season. For spring is the Brāhmaṇa's own season. If he sacrifices in his own season, he becomes endowed with Brahmanical splendour. This spring season is the first (or the chief) of all the seasons; therefore one who sacrifices in the chief season of all becomes esteemed and honoured among men. A Kṣatriya should sacrifice in the Grīṣma season, for Grīṣma is the Kṣatriya's own season. A Kṣatriya who sacrifices in his own season becomes mighty. A Vaiśya should sacrifice in the autumn season, for autumn is the Vaiśya's own season. A Vaiśya who sacrifices in his own season becomes possessed of wealth such as cattle. Thus the rule of seasons laid down for Brāhmaṇas, Kṣatriyas and Vaiśyas is stated here. This description of nature accords with the description in the present Ṛk, *traināka*, "having three qualities".

Moreover, the description of threefold natures by epithets such as *tryudhā*, *tripājasyaḥ* and *tryanīkaḥ* may be said to show that the seasons, the limbs of the year, represent the three worlds.

संवत्सर एषोऽग्निरिम उ लोकाः संवत्सरः तस्य यदूर्ध्वं पृथिव्या अर्वाचीनमंतरिक्षात्तदस्यैषा द्वितीया चितिस्तद्वस्य ग्रीष्म ऋतुः ॥ (*saṃvatsara eṣo 'gnirima u lokāḥ saṃvatsaraḥ tasya yadūrdhvaṃ pṛthivyā arvācīnamaṃtarikṣāttadasyaiṣā dvitīyā citistadvasya grīṣma ṛtuḥ ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 8-2-1-7).

This year reflects the three worlds as well. Its limbs, the seasons, are the representatives of the respective worlds. The world that is above the earth and below the atmosphere has the form of the Grīṣma season. (Spring is included in it; the sense is that the first pair of seasons reflects the first world.)

संवत्सर एषोग्निरिम उ लोकाः संवत्सरस्तस्यांतरिक्षमेव मध्यमा चितिरंतरिक्षमस्य वर्षा शरदावृतू तद्यदेता अत्रोपदधाति । (*saṃvatsara eṣognirima u lokāḥ saṃvatsarastasyāṃtarikṣameva madhyamā citiraṃtarikṣamasya varṣā śaradāvṛtū tadyadetā atropadadhāti |*) (Śa. Brā. 8-3-2-7).

The principle of these three worlds is contained in the year itself. The second fire-layer reflects the atmosphere, the middle of these worlds. The rainy season and autumn, the middle limbs of the year, are both representatives of this atmosphere; that is, they have that nature.

यदूर्ध्वमंतरिक्षात् अर्वाचीनं दिवः तदस्यैषा चतुर्थी चितिस्तद्वस्य हेमंत ऋतुः ॥ (*yadūrdhvamamṃtarikṣāt arvācīnaṃ divaḥ tadasyaiṣā caturthī citistadvasya hemaṃta ṛtuḥ ||*) (Śa. Brā. 8-4-2-15).

The representative of the world that lies above the atmosphere and at the side of the heavenly world is the Hemanta season. In this way the limbs of the year reflect the limbs of the three worlds. Since the one principle of Agni pervades the three worlds also in the forms of Vāyu and Āditya, this Agni is the all-pervading Lord.

प्रजापतिरेषोग्निः संवत्सर उ प्रजापतिस्तस्य यदूर्ध्वं .... (*prajāpatireṣogniḥ saṃvatsara u prajāpatistasya yadūrdhvaṃ ....*) (Śa. Brā. 8-4-2-16).

This Agni is Prajāpati, the all-pervading one, the cause of the creation of the universe. This Prajāpati is the three worlds. These worlds are the all-pervading year. The seasons, the limbs of this year, reflect also the limbs of Prajāpati. Thus they declare the greatness of the principle of the year, which has three qualities (*traināka*).

ऋषभो वा एष ऋतूनां यत्संवत्सरः ... . ऋषभ एष यज्ञानां । (*ṛṣabho vā eṣa ṛtūnāṃ yatsaṃvatsaraḥ ... . ṛṣabha eṣa yajñānāṃ |*) (Śa. Brā. 13-1-2-2).

As the Aśvamedha, which gives the most excellent fruit, is the best of all sacrifices, so the year is the bull among the seasons. This description shows the purport of the epithet *vṛṣabhaḥ* in the present Ṛk.

Retodhāḥ: this epithet may refer to Āditya or to the year. It was stated earlier that the rays of Āditya are described by the word *retas*. *Retas* means either the seed that produces the world, or the water that is the cause of the origin and protection of beings. And when explaining the sentence आपो वै सर्वे देवा सर्वाणि भूतानि (*āpo vai sarvè devā sarvāṇi bhūtāni*) (Śa. Brā. 10-5-4-14), Sāyaṇa said: अर्चिषो ह्यापसूरकिरणानामेव वृष्टिकर्तकृत्वात् कार्यकारणयोरभेदेन अर्चिवा आप इत्युक्तं । (*arciṣo hyāpasūrakiraṇānāmeva vṛṣṭikartakṛtvāt kāryakāraṇayorabhedena* *arcivā āpa ityuktaṃ* |). Since he says that, because the sun's rays are the cause of the streams of water, the rays are described figuratively as streams, the word *retas* here too can be given that meaning. Moreover, when explaining the sentence षळिद्यमा ऋषयो देवजा इति (*ṣaḷidyamā ṛṣayo devajā iti*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-15), he said षड्रश्मयः षण्णां ऋतूनां प्रवर्तकाः (*ṣaḍraśmayaḥ ṣaṇṇāṃ ṛtūnāṃ pravartakāḥ*): the six rays of Āditya are the causes of the six seasons. Just as the rays of Āditya are described as *retodhāḥ*, in the same way in the present Ṛk the limbs of the year are described as *retodhāḥ*.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒भीक॑ं आसां प॒दवीर॑बोध्यादि॒त्याना॑मह्वे॒ चारु॒ नाम॑ ।
आप॑श्चिदस्मा अरमन्त दे॒वीः पृ॒थग्व्रज॑न्ती॒ः परि॑ षीमवृञ्जन् ॥ ४ ॥

> *abhīka āsāṃ padavīrabodhyādityānāmahve cāru nāma |*
> *āpaścidasmā aramanta devīḥ pṛthagvrajantīḥ pari ṣīmavṛñjan ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभीके । आसां । पदवीः । अबोधि । आदित्यानां । अह्वे । चारु । नाम ।
> आपः । चित् । अस्मै । अरमंत । देवीः । पृथक् । व्रजंतीः । परि । सीं । अव्वंजन् ॥

> *abhīke | āsāṃ | padavīḥ | abodhi | ādityānāṃ | ahve | cāru | nāma | āpaḥ | cit | asmai | aramaṃta | devīḥ | pṛthak | vrajaṃtīḥ | pari | sīṃ | avvaṃjan ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> संवत्सर आसामोषधीनामभीके समीपे पदवीः । पदानि तत्तद्वनविशिष्टपुष्पफलादीनि वेति प्रजनयतीति पदवीः सन् अबोधि । बुध्यते । सावधानो वर्तते ।

> *saṃvatsara āsāmoṣadhīnāmabhīke samīpe padavīḥ | padāni tattadvanaviśiṣṭapuṣpaphalādīni veti prajanayatīti padavīḥ san abodhi | budhyate | sāvadhāno vartate |*

> तथादित्यानां । आदित्या मासाः संख्यासाम्यात् । यद्वा ।
> आदित्यसंक्रमणनिमित्तत्वादादित्या मासाः । मेषादिस्थे सवितरि यो यो मासः प्रपूर्यते चांद्रश्चैत्राद्यः
> स ज्ञेय इति स्मृतेः । तेषां चैत्रादीनां मासानां चारु नाम मधुश्च माधवश्चेत्यादि नामधेयमहे । आह्वयामि । उच्चारयामीत्यर्थः । किंच देवीर्द्योतनशीलाः पृथगितस्ततो व्रजंतीर्गच्छंत्य अपश्चित् आपोऽप्यस्मै संवत्सरायारमंत ।
> संवत्सरसंबंधिमासचतुष्टये वृष्टिद्वारा रमंते । ता आपः सीमेनं संवत्सरं
> पर्यवृंजन् । अष्टसु मासेषु परिवर्जयंति ॥ पदवीः । वी गत्यादिषु । क्विप् ।
> अबोधि । बुध अवगमन इत्यस्य लुजि दीपजनबुधपूरितायिप्यायिभ्योऽन्यतरस्यामिति कर्तरि चिणो लुक् । निघातः । आदित्यानां । आदित्यसंबंधिन इत्यर्थे दित्यदित्यादित्यपत्युत्तरपदाण्ण्य इति ण्यः । अतोलोपयलोपौ । प्रत्ययस्वरः । अह्वे । ह्वयतेर्लुजि सिच आत्मनेपदेष्टन्यतरस्यामित्यजादेशः । गुणः । निघातः । अवृंजन् । वृजी वर्जन इत स्य लजः श्वमि रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *tathādityānāṃ | ādityā māsāḥ saṃkhyāsāmyāt | yadvā |*
> *ādityasaṃkramaṇanimittatvādādityā māsāḥ | meṣādisthe savitari yo yo māsaḥ prapūryate cāṃdraścaitrādyaḥ*
> *sa jñeya iti smṛteḥ | teṣāṃ caitrādīnāṃ māsānāṃ cāru nāma madhuśca mādhavaścetyādi nāmadheyamahe | āhvayāmi | uccārayāmītyarthaḥ | kiṃca devīrdyotanaśīlāḥ pṛthagitastato vrajaṃtīrgacchaṃtya apaścit āpo 'pyasmai saṃvatsarāyāramaṃta |*
> *saṃvatsarasaṃbaṃdhimāsacatuṣṭaye vṛṣṭidvārā ramaṃte | tā āpaḥ sīmenaṃ saṃvatsaraṃ*
> *paryavṛṃjan | aṣṭasu māseṣu parivarjayaṃti || padavīḥ | vī gatyādiṣu | kvip |*
> *abodhi | budha avagamana ityasya luji dīpajanabudhapūritāyipyāyibhyo 'nyatarasyāmiti kartari ciṇo luk | nighātaḥ | ādityānāṃ | ādityasaṃbaṃdhina ityarthe dityadityādityapatyuttarapadāṇṇya iti ṇyaḥ | atolopayalopau | pratyayasvaraḥ | ahve | hvayaterluji sica ātmanepadeṣṭanyatarasyāmityajādeśaḥ | guṇaḥ | nighātaḥ | avṛṃjan | vṛjī varjana ita sya lajaḥ śvami rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ||*

Summary

The year (संवत्सर (*saṃvatsara*)) is "awake" (अबोधि (*abodhi*)), that is, it is attentive, near these plants (*āsāmoṣadhīnāṃ*), as पदवीः (*padavīḥ*). He explains पदानि (*padāni*) as the flowers, fruits and the like special to this or that forest, and the year produces them.[?153]

Likewise आदित्यानां (*ādityānāṃ*): the Ādityas are the months, from the equality of number (twelve). Or else: the months are Ādityas because they are caused by the sun's passage (from sign to sign). He cites the smṛti: when the sun stands in Meṣa and the other signs, the lunar month beginning with Caitra that is then filled out is to be known by that sign. Of those months, Caitra and the others, "I call" (अह्वे (*ahve*)), that is, I utter, the beautiful names, Madhu, Mādhava and so on. Further, the shining (देवीः (*devīḥ*)) waters (अपश्चित् (*apaścit*) = *āpo 'pi*), going hither and thither, delight (अरमंत (*aramaṃta*)) in this year: in the four months belonging to the year they take delight through rain. Those waters avoid (पर्यवृंजन् (*paryavṛṃjan*)) this year (सीं (*sīṃ*) = *enaṃ*) in eight months. The rest of the block gives grammar, which is left out here.

Word-to-word meaning

- संवत्सरः (*saṃvatsaraḥ*)—the year
- आसां (*āsāṃ*)—of these plants
- अभीके(*abhīke*)—which are near
- पदवीः (*padavīḥ*)—the paths (the fruits, flowers and so on of the respective plants)
- अबोधि (*abodhi*)—knows
- आदित्यानां (*ādityānāṃ*)—of the twelve months beginning with Caitra
- चारु (*cāru*)—beautiful
- नाम (*nāma*)—names
- अह्वे (*ahve*)—I utter and recite
- देवीः (*devīḥ*)—shining
- पृथक् (*pṛthak*)—in separate forms
- व्रजंतीः (*vrajaṃtīḥ*)—flowing
- अपश्चित् (*apaścit*)—waters
- अस्मै (*asmai*)—in the rain-time of this year
- अरमंत (*aramaṃta*)—rest
- सीं (*sīṃ*)—this same year
- परि अवृंजन् (*pari avṛṃjan*)—(in the remaining seasons) abandon

Gist

The year knows the nature of the flowers, fruits and the like that belong to each plant according to the season. I utter and recite the beautiful names of the twelve months beginning with Caitra. The shining waters, flowing in separate forms, rest in the rain-time of this year; they abandon this same year in the remaining seasons.

English translation

(The year) is awake, the path in the vicinity of those (plants) : I call upon the beautiful name of the Adityas; the divine waters wandering severally (now) give it delight, and (now) depart from it.

Special Topics

The nature of the year, the seat of prosperity, is described in this Ṛk also. The members of the year, the causes of abundance of food, and its divisions beginning with the seasons, are praised.

Abhīke—The word अभीक (*abhīka*) is read among the names of battle and also among the names of "near" (Ni. 2-17; 3-29). प्रसित्त्ये (*prasittye*) and अभीके (*abhīke*) are two synonymous words. The word अभीक (*abhīka*) is formed from the root अंच (*aṃca*), meaning "to go", joined with the prefix अभि (*abhi*). The use of this word in the Ṛk

ज्योतिरद्यदन्ने अकृणोदु लोकं प्रावन्मनुं दस्यवे करभीकं । (*jyotiradyadanne akṛṇodu lokaṃ prāvanmanuṃ dasyave karabhīkaṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-92-5)

makes the situation clear. The radiance of King Soma is described here. This radiance protects the good and punishes the wicked. The text says that it protected Manu and confronted the Dasyu. To say "confronted", it says that अभीकं (*abhīkaṃ*) became inclined to go towards the enemy; that is, it tried to confront and punish the enemy. Likewise in

यो दभ्रेभिर्हव्यो यश्च भूरिभिर्यो अभिके वरिवोविन्नृषाह्ये । (*yo dabhrebhirhavyo yaśca bhūribhiryo abhike varivovinnṛṣāhye* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-38-4)

and similar places the meaning is likewise "battle". The sense is that Indra is invoked at times of battle just as at times of sacrifice. In some places the word also means a secluded place. For example, in

ज्योतिर्वृणीत तमसो विजानन्नारे स्याम दुरितादभीके। (*jyotirvṛṇīta tamaso vijānannāre syāma duritādabhīke* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-39-7)

दुरितादभीके(*duritādabhīke*) means "in a secluded region free of sin". In the present Ṛk, अभीके पदवीः (*abhīke padavīḥ*) means an object that surrounds and is near.

The bhāṣya states that the word अदित्यानां (*adityānāṃ*) is a synonym for the members of the year. Sāyaṇa explains as follows how the word Āditya is used for a month. First, संख्या साम्यात् आदित्याः मासाः । (*saṃkhyā sāmyāt ādityāḥ māsāḥ* |) The number of months is twelve and the number of Ādityas is twelve; therefore the word Āditya is meant to denote the twelve months. Or, secondly, because of the connection with the sun's transit, each month is called by the usage "Āditya". Such transits, beginning with Meṣa, are twelve. Therefore the meaning here is that Āditya is the month.

Cāru nāma—Because the number of the months follows the number of the Ādityas, the word आदित्यानां (*ādityānāṃ*), which expresses identity, is used. To show that the names of these months are very attractive and satisfying, they are described as चारु नाम (*cāru nāma*). Madhu, Mādhava, Śukra, Śuci, Nabha, Nabhasya, Iṣa, Ūrja, Saha, Sahasya, Tapa and Tapasya are the names of the twelve months. These are called the twelve months beginning with Caitra. To understand how the epithet चारु नाम (*cāru nāma*) fits these names, one must know the description of their nature.

उपयाम गृहीतोऽसि मधवे त्वेत्येवाध्वर्युर्गृह्णात्युपयामगृहीतोऽसि माधवाय त्वेति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतावेव वासंतिकौ स यद्वसंत ओषधयो जायंते वनस्पतयः पच्यंते तेनो हैतौ मधुश्च माधवश्च । (*upayāma gṛhīto 'si madhave tvetyevādhvaryurgṛhṇātyupayāmagṛhīto 'si mādhavāya tveti pratiprasthātaitāveva vāsaṃtikau sa yadvasaṃta oṣadhayo jāyaṃte vanaspatayaḥ pacyaṃte teno haitau madhuśca mādhavaśca* |) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-1-14)

Of the seasonal cups, the Adhvaryu takes one and the Pratiprasthātṛ the other. The Adhvaryu recites "I offer this to Madhu", and the Pratiprasthātṛ "I offer this to Mādhava" (Vā. Saṃ. 7-30). Madhu and Mādhava are both months of the spring season. In this season the plants and the rest become laden with fruit and flowers, and the trees bear ripe fruit. Because trees and the rest thus have sweetness, the two names Madhu and Mādhava are well known for the two months that are members of this season.

उपयाम गृहीतोऽसि । शुक्राय तैत्येवाध्वर्युर्गृह्णात्युपयामगृहीतोऽसि शुचये त्वेति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतानेव गैष्मौ स यदेतयोर्बलिष्ठं तपति तेनो हैत् शुक्रश्च शुचिश्च ॥ (*upayāma gṛhīto 'si | śukrāya taityevādhvaryurgṛhṇātyupayāmagṛhīto 'si śucaye tveti pratiprasthātaitāneva gaiṣmau sa yadetayorbaliṣṭhaṃ tapati teno hait śukraśca śuciśca* ‖) (Ka Brā. 4-3-1-15)[?154]

The Adhvaryu takes the third cup and the Pratiprasthātṛ the fourth. The Adhvaryu recites "I offer this to Śukra", and the Pratiprasthātṛ "I offer this to Śuci". Śukra and Śuci are both members of the summer season. Because there is intense heat at that time, they have these names. Śukra means bright, and Śuci means radiant.

उपयामगृहीतोऽसि नभसे तैत्येवाध्वर्युर्गृह्ण्यात्युपयामगृहीतोऽसि नभस्याय तैति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतावेव वार्षिकावमुतो वै दिवो वर्षति तेनो हैत् नभश्च नभस्यश्च ॥ (*upayāmagṛhīto 'si nabhase taityevādhvaryurgṛhṇyātyupayāmagṛhīto 'si nabhasyāya taiti pratiprasthātaitāveva vārṣikāvamuto vai divo varṣati teno hait nabhaśca nabhasyaśca* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-196)[?155]

Then the offering is made to Nabha and Nabhasya. Both are months connected with the rainy season. Because rain falls from the sky, the names Nabha and Nabhasya are well known for these two.

इषे त्वेत्येवाध्वर्युर्गह्णाति .... ऊर्जेत्वेति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतावेव शरदौ स यच्छरद्यूर्ग्रस ओषधयः पच्यंते तेनो हैतानिषश्चोर्जश्च ॥ (*iṣe tvetyevādhvaryurgahnāti .... ūrjetveti pratiprasthātaitāveva śaradau sa yaccharadyūrgrasa oṣadhayaḥ pacyaṃte teno haitāniṣaścorjaśca* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-1-17)

Again the offering is made to Iṣa and Ūrja. Iṣa means sap, and Ūrja means food. Both are members of the autumn season. In this autumn the plants and the rest become full of sap and there is abundance of food, so the names Iṣa and Ūrja are well known.

उपयामगृहीतोऽसि सहसे तैत्येवाध्वर्युर्गृष्णाति उपयामगृहीतोऽसि सहस्याय त्वेति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतावेव हैमंतिकौ स यद्धेमंत इमाः प्रजाः सहसेव स्वं वशमुपनयते तेनो हैतौ सहश्च सहस्यश्च ॥ (*upayāmagṛhīto 'si sahase taityevādhvaryurgṛṣṇāti upayāmagṛhīto 'si* *sahasyāya tveti pratiprasthātaitāveva haimaṃtikau sa yaddhemaṃta imāḥ prajāḥ sahaseva svaṃ vaśamupanayate teno haitau sahaśca sahasyaśca ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-1-18)

The offering is made to Sahas and Sahasya. Both are members of the winter (Hemanta) season. Hemanta draws all beings under its control by force. Sahas means strength or radiance. Therefore its members are named Saha and Sahasya.

तपसे त्वेत्येवाध्वर्युर्गृष्णाति उपयाम गृहीतोऽसि तपस्याय त्वेति प्रतिप्रस्थातैतावेव शैशिरा स यदेतयोर्बलिष्ठं श्यायति तेनो हैत् तपश्च तपस्यश्च ॥ (*tapase tvetyevādhvaryurgṛṣṇāti upayāma gṛhīto 'si tapasyāya tveti pratiprasthātaitāveva śaiśirā sa yadetayorbaliṣṭhaṃ śyāyati teno hait tapaśca tapasyaśca ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-1-19)

The two months Tapa and Tapasya are likewise members of the cool season (Śiśira). At this time the body shrinks with cold and wastes away, so these names are well known for the months of this season. In this way the nature of the twelve months has been described. In the same manner it is explained in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā also, beginning "मधुश्च माधवश्च (*madhuśca mādhavaśca*)" (Tai. Saṃ. 4-4-1-1).

The year, which thus contains five seasons and twelve months, is described as "पंच पादं पितरं द्वादशाकृतिं (*paṃca pādaṃ pitaraṃ dvādaśākṛtiṃ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-12). Describing the same point, the Śatapatha says:

तस्य सप्तदश सामिधेन्यः । सप्तदशो वै संवत्सरो द्वादशमासाः पंचर्तवः संवत्सरः प्रजापतिः ॥ (*tasya saptadaśa sāmidhenyaḥ | saptadaśo vai saṃvatsaro dvādaśamāsāḥ paṃcartavaḥ saṃvatsaraḥ prajāpatiḥ ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 6-2-2-8)

Prajāpati, consisting of twelve months and five seasons, is the year-self with seventeen members. Thus the text shows the relation between Prajāpati and the seventeen sāmidhenī mantras, which are a part of the sacrifice.

आसां आदित्यानां पदवीः अबोधि (*āsāṃ ādityānāṃ padavīḥ abodhi*)—Since it is said that the year, which has these twelve months and consists of the seasons, has known the nature and power of the several months, one must ask what the "path" of the several months is, and what their natures are. When the names of the months, Madhu, Mādhava, Śukra, Śuci and the rest, were given, their nature was described along with them, as stated above. The paths of the months must now be examined.

द्वादशारं नहि तज्जराय वर्वर्ति चक्रंपरि द्यामृतस्य । आ पुत्रा अग्ने मिथुनासो अत्र सप्त शतानि विंशतिश्च तस्थुः ॥ (*dvādaśāraṃ nahi tajjarāya varvarti cakraṃ pari dyāmṛtasya | ā putrā agne mithunāso atra sapta śatāni viṃśatiśca tasthuḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-11)

द्वादश प्रधयश्चक्रमेकं त्रीणि नभ्यानि क उ तच्चिकेत । तस्मिन्त्साकं त्रिशता न शंकवोऽर्पिताः षष्टिर्न चलाचलासः । (*dvādaśa pradhayaścakramekaṃ trīṇi nabhyāni ka u tacciketa | tasmintsākaṃ triśatā na śaṃkavo 'rpitāḥ ṣaṣṭirna calācalāsaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-48)

In these Ṛks, in the present sūkta, and in the two mantras above, the description is clear. The members belong to the Āditya, or to the year which has the form of Āditya. The wheel which is the year has twelve felloes and three hubs. According to one reckoning, three hundred and sixty members that revolve on this wheel are fixed together like pegs. Here the three hundred and sixty members indicate the number of days. According to another reckoning the number is seven hundred and twenty; these indicate day and night both. All these are the sons of the Āditya, or of the year that has the form of Āditya. The same reckoning is stated in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa also, in the description of the Caturviṃśa stoma. Only in the Śrautasūtra belonging to the Sāma branch are some differing reckonings found:

1. 324 days to the year: 12 months of 27 days.
2. 351 days: 12 months of 27 days and again 27 days.
3. 354 days: 6 months of 30 days and 6 months of 29 days.

The reason for the differences in reckoning, the difference between the solar and the lunar measure, and the matter of the solstices will be explained in detail later when occasion arises.

The sense is that, having such members, the year knows the path of nature, with its fruits, flowers and the like, clearly nourished according to each season.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्री ष॒धस्था॑ सिन्धव॒स्त्रिः क॑वी॒नामु॒त त्रि॑मा॒ता वि॒दथे॑षु स॒म्राट् ।
ऋ॒ताव॑री॒र्योष॑णास्ति॒स्रो अप्या॒स्त्रिरा दि॒वो वि॒दथे॒ पत्य॑मानाः ॥ ५ ॥

> *trī ṣadhasthā sindhavastriḥ kavīnāmuta trimātā vidatheṣu samrāṭ |*
> *ṛtāvarīryoṣaṇāstisro apyāstrirā divo vidathe patyamānāḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रि । सधस्था । सिंधवः । त्रिः । कवीनां । उत । त्रिमाता । विदथेषु । सम्राट् ।
> ऋत्यवरीः । योषणाः । तिस्रः । अप्याः । त्रिः । अ । दिवः । विदथे । पत्यमानाः ॥ ५ ॥

> *tri | sadhasthā | siṃdhavaḥ | triḥ | kavīnāṃ | uta | trimātā | vidatheṣu | samrāṭ |*
> *ṛtyavarīḥ | yoṣaṇāḥ | tisraḥ | apyāḥ | triḥ | a | divaḥ | vidathe | patyamānāḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रजापतिः स्वविज्ञानं सिंधूनां निवेदयति । हे सिंधव आपः सर्वसाक्षिण्यो
> यूयं । त्री षधस्था त्रयो लोकाः । ते च प्रत्येकं त्रिर्भवंति ! तथा त्रयो वा
> इमे त्रिवृतो लोका इति श्रुतिः । न द्याव इंद्रमोजसा नांतरिक्षाणि वज्रीणं न
> विव्यचंत भूमयः । ऋग्वे. ८-६-१५ । इति प्रत्येकं बहुवचनश्रवणात् । बहुवचनं
> च कपिंजलन्यायेन त्रित्वे पर्यवसितं । ते च लोकाः कवीनां देवानां निवासस्थानानि भवंति ।
> उतापि च त्रिमाता त्रयाणाममीषां लोकानां निर्माता संवत्सरः
> सूर्यो वा विदथेषु यज्ञेषु सम्राट् यजनीयतया सम्यग्दीप्यमानो वर्तते।
> तथा ऋतावरीरुदकवत्योऽप्या नभस्या आप्तव्या ना तिस्रो योषणास्त्रि संख्याका
> इलासरस्वतीभारतीत्येवंरूपाः परस्परमिश्रणोपेता देवता विदथे यज्ञे दिवो दिवसस्य

> तिस्त्रिषु सवनेष्वा पत्यमाना आगच्छंत्यो भवंति ॥ सधस्था । पूर्वपदादिति संहितायां
> षत्वं । योषणाः । युष इति सौत्रो धातुः । ल्युटि रूपं । लित्स्वरः । तिस्रः ।
> तिसृभ्यो जस इत्याद्यु दात्तत्वं । अप्याः । अप् इत्यंतरिक्षनाम । तत्र भवाः । भवे
> छंदसीति यत् । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्यु दात्तत्वं ॥

> *prajāpatiḥ svavijñānaṃ siṃdhūnāṃ nivedayati | he siṃdhava āpaḥ sarvasākṣiṇyo*
> *yūyaṃ | trī ṣadhasthā trayo lokāḥ | te ca pratyekaṃ trirbhavaṃti ! tathā trayo vā*
> *ime trivṛto lokā iti śrutiḥ | na dyāva iṃdramojasā nāṃtarikṣāṇi vajrīṇaṃ na*
> *vivyacaṃta bhūmayaḥ | ṛgve. 8-6-15 | iti pratyekaṃ bahuvacanaśravaṇāt | bahuvacanaṃ*
> *ca kapiṃjalanyāyena tritve paryavasitaṃ | te ca lokāḥ kavīnāṃ devānāṃ*
> *nivāsasthānāni bhavaṃti | utāpi ca trimātā trayāṇāmamīṣāṃ lokānāṃ nirmātā saṃvatsaraḥ*
> *sūryo vā vidatheṣu yajñeṣu samrāṭ yajanīyatayā samyagdīpyamāno vartate|*
> *tathā ṛtāvarīrudakavatyo 'pyā nabhasyā āptavyā nā tisro yoṣaṇāstri*
> *saṃkhyākā ilāsarasvatībhāratītyevaṃrūpāḥ parasparamiśraṇopetā devatā vidathe yajñè divo divasasya*
> *tistriṣu savaneṣvā patyamānā āgacchaṃtyo bhavaṃti ‖ sadhasthā | pūrvapadāditi saṃhitāyāṃ*
> *ṣatvaṃ | yoṣaṇāḥ | yuṣa iti sautro dhātuḥ | lyuṭi rūpaṃ | litsvaraḥ | tisraḥ |*
> *tisṛbhyo jasa ityādyu dāttatvaṃ | apyāḥ | ap ityaṃtarikṣanāma | tatra bhavāḥ | bhave*
> *chaṃdasīti yat | yato 'nāva ityādyu dāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Prajāpati declares his own knowledge to the rivers. "O rivers, waters, witnesses of all, you are त्री षधस्था (*trī ṣadhasthā*), the three worlds; and each of them is threefold." The Śruti says, "These three worlds are threefold." This is because the plural is heard for each of them, as in "न द्याव इंद्रमोजसा नांतरिक्षाणि वज्रीणं न विव्यचंत भूमयः (*na dyāva iṃdramojasā nāṃtarikṣāṇi vajrīṇaṃ na vivyacaṃta bhūmayaḥ*)" (Ṛg. 8-6-15); and the plural, by the kapiñjala rule, ends in the number three. Those worlds are the dwelling-places of the कवीनां (*kavīnāṃ*), the gods. Further, त्रिमाता (*trimātā*), the maker of these three worlds, the year or the sun, shines forth at the sacrifices (विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*)) as सम्राट् (*samrāṭ*), fully resplendent as the one to be worshipped. Likewise the ऋतावरीः (*ṛtāvarīḥ*), those possessing water, the अप्याः (*apyāḥ*) ... नभस्या आप्तव्या ना (*nabhasyā āptavyā nā*)?156, the three women, three in number, of the forms Iḷā, Sarasvatī and Bhāratī, deities endowed with mutual mixing, come at the sacrifice during the three pressings of the day (दिवो दिवसस्य तिस्त्रिषु सवनेष्वा (*divo divasasya tistriṣu savaneṣvā*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- सिंधवः (*siṃdhavaḥ*)—O waters in the form of streams
- कवीनां (*kavīnāṃ*)—for the gods
- त्रि षधस्था (*tri ṣadhasthā*)—the three worlds, which are dwelling-places
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—are also of three forms
- उत (*uta*)—and
- त्रिमाता (*trimātā*)—the year (or the sun), who knows the measure of these three worlds?157
- विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*)—at the sacrifices
- सम्राट् (*samrāṭ*)—has adorned the position of sovereign
- ऋतावरीः (*ṛtāvarīḥ*)—those filled with water
- अप्याः (*apyāḥ*)—having the form of rain
- तिस्रः योषणाः (*tisraḥ yoṣaṇāḥ*)—the three women also
- विदथे (*vidathe*)—at the sacrifice
- दिवः त्रिः (*divaḥ triḥ*)—at the three pressing-times of the day
- आ पत्यमानाः (*ā patyamānāḥ*)—come down

Gist

O waters in the form of streams, the three worlds, the dwelling-places of the gods, are also of three forms. And the year, or the sun, who knows the measure of these three worlds, has adorned the position of sovereign at the sacrifices. The three women, filled with water and having the form of rain, also come down every day at the three pressing-times of the sacrifice.

English translation

Rivers, the dwelling-places of the intelligent gods are thrice three; the measurer of the three (worlds) is the sovereign at sacrifices : three female (divinities) of the waters charged with the rains descend from heaven at the thrice (repeated) solemnity.

Special Topics

A very profound meaning lies in this mantra. Seen superficially, three different ideas seem to illumine three separate points: first, the all-pervading lordship of the gods; second, the greatness of the year; third, the coming of the women at the three pressing-times. But on closer view these ideas are connected with one another and finally end in the exposition of a single principle.

Before understanding what it means that the three worlds are dwelling-places for the gods and that these three worlds are threefold (trivṛt), that is, have three forms, one must note what is distinctive in the use of the word कवि (*kavi*) as a synonym for the word देव (*deva*).

कवीनां (*kavīnāṃ*)—If कवीनां (*kavīnāṃ*) is taken to mean देवानां (*devānāṃ*), one and the same entity must be indicated by both words. The context must be one in which both words denote the same form and nature. One must therefore examine what the word देवानां (*devānāṃ*) indicates. When the etymologies of the names of gods such as Indra and Agni are given, the nature of the gods is also stated.

स योऽयं मध्ये प्राणः । एष एवेंद्रस्तानेष प्राणान्मध्यत इंद्रियेणैंद यदैन्थ तस्मादिंद इंधो ह वै तमिंद्र इत्याचक्षते परोक्षं परोक्षकामा हि देवास्त्रइद्धाः सत्त नाना पुरुषानसृजंत । (*sa yo 'yaṃ madhye prāṇaḥ | eṣa eveṃdrastāneṣa prāṇānmadhyata iṃdriyeṇaiṃda yadaintha tasmādiṃda iṃdho ha vai tamiṃdra ityācakṣate parokṣaṃ parokṣakāmā hi devāstraiddhāḥ satta nānā puruṣānasṛjaṃta |*) (Śa. Brā. 6-1-1-2)

Among the vital airs within the body, the chief breath is well known as Indra. This chief breath kindles the other vital airs by its own power. Because it makes them blaze in this way, the name Indra became famous from this very quality of kindling (इंधानः (*iṃdhānaḥ*)). But one could simply call it इंधानः (*iṃdhānaḥ*); why then was it called Indra? Because the gods are always fond of what lies beyond the world. इंधानः (*iṃdhānaḥ*) would be a description in the manner of worldly poetry. To go beyond such worldly description and cross into the realm of the hidden is the mark of the gods. Hence the gods became famous as "lovers of the hidden".

अथ यो गर्भोऽंतरासीत् । सोऽग्रिरसृज्यत स यदस्य सर्वस्याग्रमसृज्यत तस्मादग्रिरग्रिर्ह वै तमग्निरित्याचक्षते परोक्षं परोक्षकामा हि देवाः । (*atha yo garbho 'ṃtarāsīt | so 'grirasṛjyata sa yadasya sarvasyāgramasṛjyata tasmādagriragrirha vai tamagnirityācakṣate parokṣaṃ parokṣakāmā hi devāḥ |*)

(Śa. Brā. 6-1-1-11)

The supreme principle that arose from the embryo within Brahman became famous as Agri. Because it was produced first of all beings in the universe, it was called Agri. The gods, who delight in the hidden sense, called this very one Agni. By these explanations the nature of the gods is described: it is the gods' character to convey, or reveal, or deepen the hidden meaning. This quality is common to gods and poets. A hidden meaning that lies beyond the ordinary human view is possible only for the gods. If that godhood is present in a man, he is called a poet (kavi). He has a vision better and more divine than that of an ordinary man. Though he has obtained human birth, he is reckoned a god.

विज्ञानमात्मानंदात्मनो हैव सर्वे देवाः सा हैषैव देवानामद्धाविद्या स ह स न मनुष्यो य एवंविद्देवानागं् हैव स एकः ॥ (*vijñānamātmānaṃdātmano haiva sarve devāḥ sā haiṣaiva devānāmaddhāvidyā sa ha sa na manuṣyo ya evaṃviddevānāgṃ haiva sa ekaḥ ||*)

(Śa. Brā. 10-3-5-13)

Vijñāna means special knowledge. It is full of bliss; true knowledge is the cause of this bliss. Such true knowledge is possible for the gods, not for man. If anyone among men is able to obtain this knowledge, he too is reckoned a god; thus the nature of godhood is shown. For this very reason they have explained the word kavi as "one who sees beyond" (krāntadarśin). The Nirukta authors have read this word among the names of the intelligent, कविः (*kaviḥ*), मनीषी (*manīṣī*) and so on (Ni. 3-15).

मेधावी कविः क्रांतदर्शनो भवति कवतेर्वा (*medhāvī kaviḥ krāṃtadarśano bhavati kavatervā*)

(Ni. 12-13)

The Nirukta authors' derivation is that this word, formed from the root क्रम् (*kram*), means one whose vision goes beyond, or, formed from the root कम् (*kam*), means a worshipper who praises. Both derivations show an intellect and a disposition that grasp the true meaning. Just as the example above explains that the gods have the power to obtain knowledge of the highest truth, so the poet too has an unworldly and extraordinary power of knowing all affairs of past, present and future. On many occasions Sāyaṇa has said that देव (*deva*) is a synonym of the word kavi. Although he is a man, the poet has godhood in him because he has divine sight; and the sense is that he has a power beyond the human. Though physically he has two eyes, his inner eye equals a thousand eyes.

सहस्रणीथाः कवयो ये गोपायंति सूर्यं । यमहीन् तपस्वतो यम शपोजा अपि गच्छतात् ॥ (*sahasraṇīthāḥ kavayo ye gopāyaṃti sūryaṃ | yamahīn tapasvato yama śapojā api gacchatāt ||*)

(Ma. Saṃ. 0-154-5)[?158]

The poets have a thousand eyes and see beyond; they have the power to protect even the Āditya. [A thousand-eyed one may mean one with a thousand eyes, or a guide to thousands of followers. If "guide" is meant, it means one who knows the meaning of the principle and has the power to teach others.] Because they have such power,

समुद्रे अंतः कवयो वि चक्षते मरीचीनां पदमिच्छंति वेधसः (*samudre aṃtaḥ kavayo vi cakṣate marīcīnāṃ padamicchaṃti vedhasaḥ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-177-1)

these poets who see beyond know the supreme principle that dwells within the orb of the Āditya, and they also desire to attain identity with it. Moreover,

तां द्योतमानां स्वर्यं मनीषामृतस्य पदे कवयो नि पांति (*tāṃ dyotamānāṃ svaryaṃ manīṣāmṛtasya pade kavayo ni pāṃti*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-173-2)

ऋतस्य पदं कवयो नि पांति गुहा नामानि दधिरे पराणि (*ṛtasya padaṃ kavayo ni pāṃti guhā nāmāni dadhire parāṇi*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-5-2)

Thus the power of the poets is described: the poets, who see beyond and possess godhood, enter the path of Ṛta and know the most hidden and most exalted secret. (This same matter is explained in detail in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, Part 13, pp. 377-379.) Because this extraordinary power is also revealed in the present mantra, the synonym कवीनां (*kavīnāṃ*) is used to designate the gods. Such gods pervade the universe; therefore they are त्रिषधस्थ (*triṣadhastha*).

त्रिषधस्था—त्रयो लोकाः देवानां निवासस्थानानि भवंति । (*triṣadhasthā—trayo lokāḥ devānāṃ nivāsasthānāni bhavaṃti* |) The three worlds are the dwelling places of the gods. Each of these is again of three kinds.

तिस्र एव देवता इति नैरुक्ताः । अग्निः पृथिवीस्थानः । वायुर्वा इंद्रो वा अंतरिक्षस्थानः । सूर्यो द्युस्थानः ॥ तासां महाभाग्यात् एकैकस्या अपि बहूनि नामधेयानि भवंति ॥ (*tisra eva devatā iti nairuktāḥ | agniḥ pṛthivīsthānaḥ | vāyurvā iṃdro vā aṃtarikṣasthānaḥ | sūryo dyusthānaḥ ‖ tāsāṃ mahābhāgyāt ekaikasyā api bahūni nāmadheyāni bhavaṃti ‖*)

(Ni. 7-5)

For the three deities Agni, Vāyu or Indra, and Āditya, the three worlds are the abode: the earth for Agni, the atmosphere for Vāyu or Indra, the heaven-world for Āditya. The Nirukta authors say that because of their greatness they have endless other names too, and thus describe the nature of the gods who occupy these three worlds. The Ṛk Saṃhitā likewise states that the three worlds are the abode of these three deities, who have endless varieties:

सूरो नो दिवस्सातु वातो अंतरिक्षात् । अग्निर्नः पार्थिवेभ्यः (*sūro no divassātu vāto aṃtarikṣāt | agnirnaḥ pārthivebhyaḥ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-158-1)

When it is prayed that Sūra of the heaven-world, Vāyu of the atmosphere and Agni of the earth protect us, the three worlds indicated by त्रिषधस्था (*triṣadhasthā*) are described.

The word सधस्थ (*sadhastha*) means a common place. In some places this word is also a synonym for the atmosphere. It is also customary to call the altar-place where all the priests sit together and perform the sacrifice सधस्थ (*sadhastha*). Moreover, as has been said earlier, Sāyaṇa in his commentary on Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-154-1 explains it as सधस्थं सह स्थानं पुण्यकृतां सहनिवासयोग्यं भूरादिलोकसप्तकं । (*sadhasthaṃ saha sthānaṃ puṇyakṛtāṃ sahanivāsayogyaṃ bhūrādilokasaptakaṃ* |), the seven worlds where the virtuous may dwell, or सहस्थानं सत्यलोकं (*sahasthānaṃ satyalokaṃ*), the Satya world, which is above all worlds and is the highest of all. Looking at त्रिषधस्था (*triṣadhasthā*) in the present passage, it is not easy to state the precise meaning. The order earth, atmosphere, heaven-world for the three deities Agni, Vāyu and Sūra is probably stated in many places. But in the Śatapatha and other texts a special feature is shown in this context:

ब्रह्म वा इदमग्र आसीत् । तद्देवानसृजत । तद्देवान्त्सृष्टैषु लोकेषु व्यारोहयदस्मिन्नेव लोकेऽग्निं वायुमंतरिक्षे दिव्येव सूर्यं । अथ येऽत ऊर्ध्वा लोकाः । तद्या आत ऊर्ध्वा देवतास्तेषु ता देवता व्यारोहयत् (*brahma vā idamagra āsīt | taddevānasrjata | taddevāntsṛṣṭaiṣu lokeṣu vyārohayadasminneva loke 'gniṃ vāyumaṃtarikṣe divyeva sūryaṃ | atha ye 'ta ūrdhvā lokāḥ | tadyā āta ūrdhvā devatāsteṣu tā devatā vyārohayat*)

(Śa. Brā. 11-2-3-1)

Brahman, who existed before the creation of the universe, created the three deities beginning with Agni and established them in the three worlds beginning with the earth. But the deities more exalted than these he established in three worlds more exalted than the earth and the rest. This is what is said. Continuing the same matter, there is an explanation that shows the unity of all the worlds. Explaining what is meant by the three worlds being threefold (trivṛt), and what the purport is, Sāyaṇa says that in the Ṛk

न द्याव इंद्रमोजसा नांतरिक्षाणि वज्रिणं । न विव्यचंत भूमयः (*na dyāva iṃdramojasā nāṃtarikṣāṇi vajriṇaṃ | na vivyacaṃta bhūmayaḥ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-6-15)

the plurals "heavens", "atmospheres", "earths" occur, and that it should be understood here in the same way. But how the threefold division is, he has not said. Later, in the commentary on the same Ṛk 8-6-15, he relies on the Āraṇyaka sentence cited, saying that they are threefold as stated in the sentence त्रयो वा इमे त्रिवृतो लोकाः (*trayo vā ime trivṛto lokāḥ*) (I. Ā. 1-1-2)[?159]. Here too the nature of the three divisions is not stated. Moreover, he says that it should be understood here as in the mantra

तिस्रो भूमीर्धारयन् त्रीगृंरुत द्यून् त्रीणि व्रता विदथे अंतरेषां (*tisro bhūmīrdhārayan trīgṃruta dyūn trīṇi vratā vidathe aṃtareṣāṃ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-27-8)

But in the cited 2-27-8 it does not mean that the earth itself is threefold. In this very Ṛk Sāyaṇa says आत्र भूमिशब्दः लोकत्रये वर्तते (*ātra bhūmiśabdaḥ lokatraye vartate*): here the word bhūmi means the three worlds. Hence it is understood that it does not mean the earth is of three kinds. He says it should be understood here as in the sentence "यो द्वितीयस्यां तृतीयस्यां पृथिव्यां (*yo dvitīyasyāṃ tṛtīyasyāṃ pṛthivyāṃ*)". Whether, therefore, the earth and the rest are each individually of three kinds, or whether naming one is as if naming the other three as well, will be examined later.

त्रिमाता—त्रयाणां अमीषां लोकानां निर्माता संवत्सरः सूरोऽन्या । (*trimātā—trayāṇāṃ amīṣāṃ lokānāṃ nirmātā saṃvatsaraḥ sūro 'nyā* |) The year, or Sūrya, the maker of these three worlds beginning with the earth. Since the description विदधेषु सम्राट् (*vidadheṣu samrāṭ*) is present, one must examine whether त्रिमाता (*trimātā*) means the year alone, or Sūrya alone, or whether being sovereign in the sacrifice (vidatha) is natural to both the year and Sūrya. How

Sūrya can be the triple maker and sovereign in the sacrifice, so, only if the year also has both functions, is त्रिमाता (*trimātā*) here one of the two; that is the purport.

The year too has obtained the quality of triple maker only through Āditya. The relation of Āditya and the year is itself the root of the origin of all gods, men and the rest in the three worlds. Agni, Āditya and the year, these three principles are the lords of the sacrifice. From the union of these three the sacrifice arises; the sacrifice is the root of creation, and the sacrifice is the root of this union. Thus the identity of cause and effect also explains the beginninglessness of creation and the relation of sacrifice to creation.

अप्पु हिमे लोकाः प्रतिष्ठिता आदित्य आसज्जनमादित्ये हीमे लोका दिग्भिरासक्ताः....संवत्सर एषोऽग्निर्यतवः शिक्क्यमृतुभिर्हि संवत्सरः शक्नोति.... (*appu hime lokāḥ pratiṣṭhitā āditya āsajjanamāditye hīme lokā digbhirāsaktāḥ....saṃvatsara eṣo 'gniryatavaḥ śikkyamṛtubhirhi saṃvatsaraḥ śaknoti....*)

(Śa. Brā. 6-7-1-17, 18)

The principle of creation set out in such sentences, and its relation to the principle of sacrifice, will also be explained later in the commentary on the Puruṣa Sūkta.

विधथेषु (*vidhatheṣu*)—The use of the word vidatha in the senses of knowledge, sacrifice, sacrificial assembly, observance of rule, and the sacrificial power indicated thereby, has been explained earlier.

तिस्रः योषणाः आ पत्यमानाः (*tisraḥ yoṣaṇāḥ ā patyamānāḥ*) At the time of sacrifice three women descend. The commentator says they are Iḷā, Bhāratī and Sarasvatī. The nature of these three deities has been told earlier, when the Āprī Sūktas were explained (Ṛgveda Saṃhitā Part 11, pp. 263-266). Even so, in the present passage, where the description is headed by Āditya, one must examine what relation these three deities, who have a sacrificial connection, have with Āditya.

देव्यस्ति स्रः श्रिताश्चैनं त्वष्टा चैवैतदाश्रयः (*devyasti sraḥ śritāścainaṃ tvaṣṭā caivaitadāśrayaḥ*)

(Bṛ. De. 1-108)

A sentence of the Bṛhaddevatā says that the three goddesses have resorted to this Agni and are contained within Agni; and in the sentences that follow it is stated still more clearly:

तिप्रस्तु देव्यो याः प्रोक्तास्तिस्थानैवेह सा तु वाक् । त्रिविधेनोच्यते नाम्ना ज्योतिषु त्रिषु वर्तिनी ॥ अग्निमेवानुगेळा तु मध्यं प्राप्ता सरस्वती । अमू स्थिताधिलोकं तु भारती भवति ह्यसौ ॥ सैषा तु त्रिविधा वाग्वै दिवि च व्योम्नि चेह च । व्यस्ता चैव समस्ता च भजत्यग्नीनिमानपि ॥ (*tiprastu devyo yāḥ proktāstisthānaiveha sā tu vāk | trividhenocyate nāmnā jyotiṣu triṣu vartinī ‖ agnimevānugeḷā tu madhyaṃ prāptā sarasvatī | amū sthitādhilokaṃ tu bhāratī bhavati hyasau ‖ saiṣā tu trividhā vāgvai divi ca vyomni ceha ca | vyastā caiva samastā ca bhajatyagnīnimānapi ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 3-12 to 14)

अयं प्रयोगस्त्वेतेषां ज्योतिषां त्रिषु वर्ततां । (*ayaṃ prayogastveteṣāṃ jyotiṣāṃ triṣu vartatāṃ |*)

(Bṛ. De. 1.90)

त्रिसो देव्यति (*triso devyati*) means the presiding goddesses of speech, who are in the three worlds. Of them Iḷā followed the earthly Agni; Sarasvatī occupied the middle world; Bhāratī became resident in the heaven-world. Yet all three goddesses serve the earthly Agni. In some places the word इळा (*iḷā*) is explained as food in the form of the oblation. In इळायास्पुत्रो वयुनेऽजनिष्ट (*iḷāyāsputro vayune 'janiṣṭa*) the relation of Iḷā to Agni is shown. Epithets such as धृतपदी धृतहस्ता (*dhṛtapadī dhṛtahastā*) are likewise words indicating a connection with Agni.

आ नो यज्ञं भारती ताम्रमेवा मनुष्पदिह चेतॆयंती । तिस्रो देवीर्बर्हिरेदं स्योनं सरस्वती स्वपसः सदंतु ॥ (*ā no yajñaṃ bhāratī tāmramevā manuṣpadiha cetèyaṃtī | tisro devīrbarhiredaṃ syonaṃ sarasvatī svapasaḥ sadaṃtu ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-110-8)

Citing this Ṛk, the Nirukta authors have explained the above purport clearly. भरतः आदित्यः तस्य भाः भारती (*bharataḥ ādityaḥ tasya bhāḥ bhāratī*) (Ni. 8-13): Bharata is Sūrya; his radiance is named Bhāratī. सर इत्युदकनाम । तद्वती स्तनितादिरूपा माध्यमिका च वाक् । (*sara ityudakanāma | tadvatī stanitādirūpā mādhyamikā ca vāk |*): Sarasvatī is a transformed form of the atmospheric goddess of speech, who has water and the sound of thunder and the like. Thus Bhāratī is the radiance of Āditya of the heaven-world; Sarasvatī is the manifestation of Vāyu of the atmosphere; Iḷā is the radiance of the earthly Agni. In this way these three deities, as representatives of the three worlds, give primacy to the sacrifice and take part in it. Moreover,

तस्मा अग्निर्भारतः शर्म यंसज्ज्योक्षश्यात्सूर्यमुच्चरंतं ॥ (*tasmā agnirbhārataḥ śarma yaṃsajyokṣaśyātsūryamuccaraṃtaṃ ॥*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-25-4)

Since in this Ṛk the word भारतः (*bhārataḥ*) is an epithet of Agni, some hold that the radiance connected with him may be named Bhāratī.

होतायक्षत्तिस्रो देवीरपसामपस्तमा अच्छिद्रमद्येदमपस्तन्वतां । देवेभ्यो देवीर्देवमपो वियंत्वाज्यस्य होतरज ॥ (*hotāyakṣattisro devīrapasāmapastamā acchidramadyedamapastanvatāṃ | devebhyo devīrdevamapo viyaṃtvājyasya hotaraja ॥*)

(Śai. Brā. 3-6-2-2)?160

In explaining this sentence of the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa it is said: इडा,सरस्वती, भारतीत्येवंरूपास्तिस्रोऽष्टमप्रयाजदेव्यस्तद्रूपमग्निं दैव्यो होता यजतु । (*iḍā,sarasvatī, bhāratītyevaṃrūpāstisro 'ṣṭamaprayājadevyastadrūpamagniṃ daivyo hotā yajatu |*). Iḷā, Sarasvatī and Bhāratī, these three are the deities of the eighth prayāja mantra, goddesses that reflect Agni.

This Agni, the lord of the whole sacrifice, who has all three of these forms, is the Āditya described in the present Ṛk.

एतद्भूतेषु लोकेषु अग्निभूतं स्थितं त्रिधा । ऋषयो गीर्भिरर्चंति व्यंजितं नामभिस्त्रिभिः ॥ (*etadbhūteṣu lokeṣu agnibhūtaṃ sthitaṃ tridhā | ṛṣayo gīrbhirarcaṃti vyaṃjitaṃ nāmabhistribhiḥ ॥*) (Bṛ. De. 1-64)

This Agni is present in all beings and in all worlds, and he abides in the form of fire. He became manifest in a different form in each of the three worlds, and he is praised under the names Agni, Vāyu and Āditya. The three powers who are special manifestations of such an Agni (Iḍā, Sarasvatī and Bhāratī) are asked to come at the three times of pressing (savana) and see that the sacrifice is completed in all its parts.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रिरा दि॒वः स॑वि॒तर्वार्या॑णि दि॒वेदि॑व॒ आ सु॑व॒ त्रिर्नो॒ अह्नः॑ ।
त्रि॒धातु॑ रा॒य आ सु॑वा॒ वसू॑नि॒ भग॑ त्रातर्धिषणे सा॒तये॑ धाः ॥ ६ ॥

> *trirā divaḥ savitarvāryāṇi divediva ā suva trirno ahnaḥ |*
> *tridhātu rāya ā suvā vasūni bhaga trātardhiṣaṇe sātaye dhāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रिः । आ । दिवः । सवितः । वार्याणि । दिवेऽदिवे । आ । सुव । त्रिः । नः । अह्नः ।
> त्रिधातु । रायः । आ । सुव । वसूनि । भग । त्रातः । धिषणे । सातये । धाः ॥ ६ ॥

> *triḥ | ā | divaḥ | savitaḥ | vāryāṇi | dive 'dive | ā | suva | triḥ | naḥ | ahnaḥ |*
> *tridhātu | rāyaḥ | ā | suva | vasūni | bhaga | trātaḥ | dhiṣaṇe | sātaye | dhāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सवितः सर्वस्य प्रेरक हे आदित्य दिवो द्युलोकादागत्य त्वं वार्याणि सर्वैः
> संभजनीयानि धनानि दिने दिने प्रतिदिनं त्रिरा सुव । त्रिवारमस्मभ्यं प्रेरय । प्रयच्छेत्यर्थः ।
> तदेवोच्यते । भग सर्वैर्भजनीय त्रातरस्माकं रक्षक हे आदित्य त्रिधातु
> त्रिधातूनि पशुकनकरत्नभेदेन त्रिप्रकाराणि वसूनि धनानि रायः । रांति क्षीरादीनीति
> रायो गोधनानि । तानि च नोऽस्मभ्यमह्नः संबंधिषु त्रिस्त्रिषु सवनेष्वा सुव ।
> प्रयच्छ । धिषणे माध्यमिके हे वाक् सातये धनलाभाय धाः । आस्मान् कुरु ॥
> त्रिः । द्वित्रिचतुर्भ्यः सुच् । पा ५–४–१८ । इति सुच् । चित्स्वरः । सुव । शू प्रेरणे ।
> तुदादिः । लोटि रूपं । त्रिधातु । डुधाण् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्मात्सितनिगमिमसीत्यादिना
> तुन्प्रत्ययः । धिषणे । आमंत्रितत्वान्निघातः ॥

> *savitaḥ sarvasya preraka he āditya divo dyulokādāgatya tvaṃ vāryāṇi sarvaiḥ*
> *saṃbhajanīyāni dhanāni dine dine pratidinaṃ trirā suva |*

> *trivāramasmabhyaṃ preraya | prayacchetyarthaḥ | tadevocyate | bhaga sarvairbhajanīya trātarasmākaṃ rakṣaka he āditya tridhātu*
> *tridhātūni paśukanakaratnabhedena triprakārāṇi vasūni dhanāni rāyaḥ | rāṃti kṣīrādīnīti*
> *rāyo godhanāni | tāni ca no 'smabhyamahnaḥ saṃbaṃdhiṣu tristriṣu savaneṣvā suva |*
> *prayaccha | dhiṣaṇe mādhyamike he vāk sātaye dhanalābhāya dhāḥ | āsmān kuru ‖*
> *triḥ | dvitricaturbhyaḥ suc | pā 5-4-18 | iti suc | citsvaraḥ | suva | śū preraṇe |*
> *tudādiḥ | loṭi rūpaṃ | tridhātu | ḍudhāṇ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasmātsitanigamimasītyādinā tunpratyayaḥ |*
> *dhiṣaṇe | āmaṃtritatvānnighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Savitṛ" is the impeller of all. Sāyaṇa addresses him as Āditya: "O Āditya, coming from the heavenly world, bestow on us every day, three times, the desirable (vāryāṇi) riches that all may enjoy." Ā suva means "impel, give." He then says what is asked. "Bhaga" is the one whom all revere, and "trātṛ" is our protector, so both address Āditya. "Tridhātu" means riches (vasūni) of three kinds: cattle, gold and jewels. "Rāyaḥ" means cattle-wealth, so called because it gives (rānti) milk and so on. These riches are to be given to us at each of the three pressings belonging to the day. "Dhiṣaṇe" is the middle (mādhyamikā) Vāk; "sātaye" means for the gain of wealth, and "dhāḥ" means "make us (so)."

Word-to-word meaning

- सवितः (*savitaḥ*)—O Āditya, impeller of the world
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—coming from the heavenly world
- वार्याणि (*vāryāṇi*)—riches desired by all
- दिवेदिवे (*divedive*)—every day
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—at the three times
- आ सुव (*ā suva*)—supply
- भग (*bhaga*)—O Āditya, in the form of Bhaga, revered by all
- त्रातः (*trātaḥ*)—protector

- त्रिधातु (*tridhātu*)—in the forms of cattle, gold and jewels
- वसूनि (*vasūni*)—riches
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—wealth in the form of cattle
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- अह्नः (*ahnaḥ*)—of each day
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—at the time of the three pressings
- आ सुव (*ā suva*)—supply
- धिषणे (*dhiṣaṇe*)—O middle Vāk
- सातये (*sātaye*)—for the gain of our wealth
- धाः (*dhāḥ*)—show favour

Gist

O Āditya, impeller of the world, come from the heavenly world and supply, every day at the three times, the riches that all desire. O Āditya, in the form of Bhaga, revered and protector of all, supply to us at the three pressings of each day riches in the form of cattle, gold and jewels, and wealth in the form of cattle. O goddess Vāk of the middle region, show favour so that we may gain wealth.

English translation

Savitri, desended fron heaven, bestow upon us blessings thrice every day: Bhaga, saviour, grant us thrice a day riches of three elements: Dhishana enable us to acquire (wealth).

Special Topics

In this mantra a prayer for the wealth desired is addressed to three deities: Savitṛ, Bhaga and Dhiṣaṇā. The sense is that these three preside over the three kinds of wealth and bestow it. From Āditya the "tridhātu" is asked for.

The word "tridhātu" has been explained as wealth in the form of cattle, gold and jewels. The word is used in many places with different meanings. Where it is used for the principles (tattva) in the form of earth, water and fire, or for the qualities (guṇa) in the form of sattva, rajas and tamas, this has been explained in detail in Ṛgveda Saṃhitā Part 11, pp. 583-586.

"Dhiṣaṇe": this word is read among the names of heaven and earth, along with "svadhe" and "purandhī" (Ni. 3-21). धिषणा वाक् धिषेर्दधात्यर्थे धीसादिनीति वा (*dhiṣaṇā vāk dhiṣerdadhātyarthe dhīsādinīti vā*) (Ni. 8-3). It is said that the word may be derived from the root धिष् (*dhiṣ*), which gives the sense "holds." Or, "dhīsādinī iti vā": it extends the intellect, that is, it makes the meaning clear. This is

the view of the Nirukta authors. In some places Sāyaṇa has explained it as Vāk in the form of mantra, and in others as the middle Vāk. In some places, such as मा च्येद्म रश्मी .... धिषणाया उपस्थे (*mā cyedma raśmī .... dhiṣaṇāyā upasthe*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-109-3), it means the bag that holds the Soma juice, as was explained earlier.

The word is used in all three numbers, and in some contexts its meaning has to be decided from the number and from the context.

When it is in the singular, it means Vāk, praise in the form of speech, or the bag that holds Soma juice. In places such as वैश्वानराय धिषणां (*vaiśvānarāya dhiṣaṇāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-2-1) it can easily be said to mean praise.

When the dual "dhiṣaṇe" is used, it generally means heaven and earth. It is formed from the root धिष् (*dhiṣ*), meaning "hold firmly," and it is a synonym for heaven and earth, which hold all the worlds. प्रजापतिर्वै प्रजाः सृष्ट्वा ता द्यावापृथिवीभ्यां पर्यागृह्णात् (*prajāpatirvai prajāḥ sṛṣṭvā tā dyāvāpṛthivībhyāṃ paryāgṛhṇāt*) (Śa. Brā. 3-8-4-17). It may be said that heaven and earth keep under their control and bear all the worlds created by Prajāpati, and are therefore known as "dhiṣaṇe."

But where the plural is used in some places, it is not easy to state the meaning of the word.

इरावतीर्वरुण धेनवो वां मधुमद्वां सिंधवो मित्र दुह्रे । त्रयस्तस्फुर्वृषभासस्ति सृणाः धिषणानां रेतोधा वि द्युमंतः ॥ (*irāvatīrvaruṇa dhenavo vāṃ madhumadvāṃ siṃdhavo mitra duhre | trayastasphurvṛṣabhāsasti sṛṇāḥ dhiṣaṇānāṃ retodhā vi dyumaṃtaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-69-2)

Here heaven and earth, together with the atmosphere within them, are included, so Sāyaṇa has explained "dhiṣaṇānām" as "of earth, atmosphere and heaven." But in this place that meaning is not directly indicated by the word. He first explains "dhiṣaṇānām" as "sthānānām" (of the places), and then, asked what the places are, explains them as the three worlds. This meaning was given earlier in the explanation of the word "dhiṣṇya." Besides this, in some other places where the plural is used, even Sāyaṇa shows a little difficulty. For example:

The passage beginning धिषणास्ता देवीः (*dhiṣaṇāstā devīḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 6-5-4-5)[?161]

These Dhiṣaṇās are dear to all the gods. They are made to blaze at the seat (sadhastha) of the earth. These Dhiṣaṇās, ancient, of divine form and dear to all the gods, are manifestations of the goddess Vāk. It is with the help of speech that everything is kindled and illumined. Where such a description is given, a hidden, essential meaning is present.

The word "dhiṣaṇe" is in the dual, and it can also be a vocative. In the present mantra, "he mādhyamike vāk" (O middle Vāk) addresses the goddess Vāk.

"Sātaye": it is formed from the root सन् (*san*), which gives the sense "obtain." Words such as वाजसातिः (*vājasātiḥ*) and वाजसातये (*vājasātaye*) are well known. Here the prayer is to show favour so that wealth may be obtained.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रिरा दि॒वः स॑वि॒ता सो॑षवीति॒ राजा॑ना मि॒त्रावरु॑णा सुपा॒णी ।
आप॑श्चिदस्य॒ रोद॑सी चिदु॒र्वी रत्नं॑ भिक्षन्त सवि॒तुः स॒वाय॑ ॥ ७ ॥

> *trirā divaḥ savitā soṣavīti rājānā mitrāvaruṇā supāṇī |*
> *āpaścidasya rodasī cidurvī ratnaṃ bhikṣanta savituḥ savāya ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रिः। आ। दिवः । सविता । सोषवीति । राजाना । मित्रावरुणा । सुपाणी इति सुपाणी ।
> आपः । चित् । अस्य । रोदसी इति । चित् । उर्वी इति । रत्नं । भिक्षंत । सवितुः। सवाय॥

> *triḥ| ā| divaḥ | savitā | soṣavīti | rājānā | mitrāvaruṇā | supāṇī iti supāṇī |*
> *āpaḥ | cit | asya | rodasī iti | cit | urvī iti | ratnaṃ | bhikṣaṃta | savituḥ| savāya‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सविता देवो दिवो दिवसस्य त्रिस्त्रिषु कालेष्टा सोषवीति । अस्मभ्यं धनान्यासुवतु । प्रेरयतु ।
> किंच राजाना राजानौ सुपाणी कल्याणपाणी मित्रावरुणावापः।
> आप्पोति सर्वं जगदित्याप अंतरिक्षं । नित्यबहुवचनांतत्वादृहुवचनं । चिदपि च
> उर्वि विस्तीर्णे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यावेता देवताः सवितुः प्रेरकस्यास्य देवस्य
> सवाय सवेन प्रेरणेन रत्नमपेक्षितमर्थं भिक्षंत । याचंते ॥ सोसवीति । पू
> प्रेरण इत्यस्य यज्लुकि लटि रूपं । मित्रावरुणा । देवताद्वंद्वे चेत्युभयपदप्रकृतिस्वरत्वं ।
> भिक्षंत । भिक्ष याज्ञायामित्यस्य लजि रूपं । सवाय । जवसव् च ।
> पा. ३-३-५६-४ । इत्यजंतत्वेन निपातनादंतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *savitā devo divo divasasya tristriṣu kāleṣṭā soṣavīti | asmabhyaṃ dhanānyāsuvatu | prerayatu | kiṃca rājānā rājānau supāṇī kalyāṇapāṇī mitrāvaruṇāvāpaḥ|*
> *āppoti sarvaṃ jagadityāpa aṃtarikṣaṃ | nityabahuvacanāṃtatvādṛhuvacanaṃ | cidapi ca*
> *urvi vistīrṇe rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyāvetā devatāḥ savituḥ prerakasyāsya devasya*
> *savāya savena preraṇena ratnamapekṣitamarthaṃ bhikṣaṃta | yācaṃte ‖ sosavīti | pū*
> *preraṇa ityasya yajluki laṭi rūpaṃ | mitrāvaruṇā | devatādvaṃdve cetyubhayapadaprakṛtisvaratvaṃ | bhikṣaṃta | bhikṣa yājñāyāmityasya laji rūpaṃ | savāya | javasav ca |*
> *pā. 3-3-56-4 | ityajaṃtatvena nipātanādaṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The god Savitṛ, three times (triḥ) each day (divaḥ), "soṣavīti": let him impel wealth to us. Further, the two kings, Mitra and Varuṇa, with fair hands (सुपाणी (*supāṇī*), "of auspicious hands"), the "āpaḥ," and the two broad ones, heaven and earth (रोदसी (*rodasī*)), these deities ask for what they want, "ratna," through the impelling (सवाय (*savāya*)) of this impelling god Savitṛ. "Āpaḥ" is the atmosphere, because it pervades (āpnoti) the whole world. It is a word that is always plural, hence the plural. "Cit" means "also." "Bhikṣanta" means "they ask."

Word-to-word meaning

सविता (*savitā*)	the god Savitṛ
दिवः (*divaḥ*)	of the day
त्रिः (*triḥ*)	at the three times
आ सोषवीति (*ā soṣavīti*)	may he supply wealth to us
राजाना (*rājānā*)	the two lords of the world
सुपाणी (*supāṇī*)	possessing excellent hands
मित्रावरुणा (*mitrāvaruṇā*)	Mitra and Varuṇa
आपः चित् (*āpaḥ cit*)	the atmosphere too
उर्वि (*urvi*)	broad
रोदसी (*rodasī*)	heaven and earth
सवितुः (*savituḥ*)	of the impeller
अस्य (*asya*)	of this god
सवाय (*savāya*)	by the impelling
रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)	wealth
भिक्षंत (*bhikṣaṃta*)	they ask

Gist

May the god Savitṛ supply us with wealth at the three times of the day. Mitra and Varuṇa, lords of the world and possessing excellent hands, the atmosphere, and the broad heaven and earth also ask for the wealth they desire from this impeller, Āditya.

English translation

May Savitri bestow upon us wealth at the (three periods) of the day, for the well-handed Mitra and Varuna, the waters, the vast heaven and earth, solicit precious things from the liberality of Savitri.

Special Topics

The present mantra praises Savitṛ: heaven and earth, Mitra and Varuṇa, and the other deities, known by epithets such as ऋतवाना (*ṛtavānā*), ऋतावृधः (*ṛtāvṛdhaḥ*) and राजाना (*rājānā*), look for Savitṛ's favour and perform their duties only by his impulsion. "उतेशिषे प्रसवस्य त्वमेक इत् (*uteśiṣe prasavasya tvameka it*)": you alone are the source and lord of the whole universe. Describing his position in this way, the mantra shows Savitṛ's greatness. What Savitṛ's place is in the sovereignty of the gods will be explained in the introduction to Ṛ. Saṃ. sūkta 3-62.

Mitra and Varuṇa have two epithets, राजाना (*rājānā*) and सुपाणी (*supāṇī*). These epithets show the nature of Mitra and Varuṇa. The nature of Mitra and Varuṇa is described in mantras such as ययोर्धाम धर्मणा रोचते बृहद्ययो रुभे रोदसी नाधसी वृत् (*yayordhāma dharmaṇā rocate bṛhadyayo rubhe rodasī nādhasī vṛt*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-65-5). They pervade the universe and shine of themselves, and they make the whole universe shine by their own light.

आपः (*āpaḥ*): आप्रोति सर्वं जगत् इत्यापः अंतरिक्षं (*āproti sarvaṃ jagat ityāpaḥ aṃtarikṣaṃ*). Because it pervades the whole world, the atmosphere has the name "āpaḥ." The Nirukta authors also include this word among the names of the atmosphere.

In some places "āpaḥ" means the water in the atmosphere, but the intended sense is understood to be the atmosphere that is its support. In some places the question "what is āpaḥ?" appears in the Śruti text itself.

प्रजां धर्मेण दाधारैवमेते मनः पितरं परिचरंत्यापश्च वरुणश्च ० यावदन्वापो यावदनु वरुणस्तावानस्यलोको भवति नास्य तावल्लोको जीर्यते यावदेतेषां न जीर्यतेऽपां च वरुणस्य च य एवमेताः मनसो विभूतिं वेद । (*prajāṃ dharmeṇa dādhāraivamete manaḥ pitaraṃ paricaraṃtyāpaśca varuṇaśca o yāvadanvāpo yāvadanu varuṇastāvānasyaloko bhavati nāsya tāvalloko jīryate yāvadeteṣāṃ na jīryate 'pāṃ ca varuṇasya ca ya evametāḥ manaso vibhūtiṃ veda* |) (I. Ā. 2-1-7)[?162]

Prajāpati, described as the Supreme Person, created Varuṇa and Apaḥ (water) by his mental resolve alone. Water serves as a help to good works, Varuṇa watches over the order of creatures, and Prajāpati makes this resolve fruitful; so they attend on him. Since this is the description, there is room for the doubt as to what the principle "āpaḥ" is. Therefore:

आसा ३ इत्याप इति तदिदमाप एवेदं वै मूलमदस्तूलमयं पितैते पुत्रा यत्र ह क्व च पुत्रस्य तत्पितुः । (*āsā 3 ityāpa iti tadidamāpa evedaṃ vai mūlamadastūlamayaṃ pitaite putrā yatra ha kva ca putrasya tatpituḥ* |) (I. Ā. 2-1-8)[?163]

What is āpaḥ? What, in truth, is the nature of this principle? Its greatness is as follows: everything in the universe is pervaded by this water; it is the root cause of the creation of the universe, and the rest is its effect. The Person who is the support of this water-principle is the father. Since this is the description, it is understood that "āpaḥ" is not merely the atmosphere, but has a wider extent than the atmosphere. The etymology given in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa also supports this view.

सेदगं् सर्वमाप्नोत्यदिदं किं च यदाप्नोत्तस्मादापः ॥ (*sedagṃ sarvamāpnotyadidaṃ kiṃ ca yadāpnottasmādāpaḥ* ‖) (Śa. Patra 6-1-19)[?164]

The etymology is that what has the power to pervade everything is known by the name "āpaḥ." But what does it pervade? In some places it is said to pervade the whole universe, moving and unmoving, and not merely one fixed world such as the atmosphere. It is also taught that it is the Supreme Brahman principle.

स योऽपो ब्रह्मेत्युपास्त आप्नोति सर्वान्यामान् ॥ (*sa yo 'po brahmetyupāsta āpnoti sarvānyāmān* ‖) (Chā. U. 7-10-2)

It says that one who worships water as Brahman obtains all the aims of human life. But here it does not mean water as the complete Brahman. Water and fire are all parts of Brahman. Even so,

Identity is stated; and it is also made known that the world of waters is a created world and not something existing before the creation of the universe:

आत्मा वा इदमेक एवाग्र आसीन्नान्यत्किंचन मिषत् । स ई क्षत । लोकान्नु सृजा इति । इमांल्लोकानसृजत । अंभोमरीचीर्मरमापः । (*ātmā vā idameka evāgra āsīnnānyatkiṃcana miṣat* | *sa ī kṣata* | *lokānnu sṛjā iti* | *imāṃllokānasṛjata* | *aṃbhomarīcīrmaramāpaḥ* |) (Ai. Ā. 9-4-1)[?165]

It says: before the creation of the universe only this principle of the Self existed; nothing else existed. Then, desiring the work of creation, it created these four worlds: Ambhaḥ, Marīci, Mara and Āpaḥ. Of these, Ambhaḥ is the heavenly world. [Ambhaḥ commonly means water, but in this quoted sentence it means the heavenly world, which lies above the atmosphere.] Marīci is the atmosphere pervaded by radiance. Mara, subject to death, is this earth. What lies below this is the world of waters (Āpaḥ). Ordinarily only the three divisions heaven, earth and atmosphere are well known, but here a fourth is added.

If such contexts are examined, a difference appears between the atmosphere as explained in the bhāṣya on the present Ṛk and the world called Āpaḥ explained in the quoted sentence. Even so, because of its pervasiveness the derivation of the word Āpaḥ fits both places. Whether it be the atmosphere or the world below the earth, the purport is that everything is nourished by the grace of Savitṛ.

उर्वी रोदसी (*urvī rodasī*)—the very extensive heaven and earth. From a gross point of view the epithet उर्वी (*urvī*) for the word रोदसी (*rodasī*) seems slightly unsuitable. The word उर्वी (*urvī*) means "very extended". रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्य विरोधनात् (*rodasī dyāvāpṛthivya virodhanāt*): because heaven and earth are bound and limited by a bounded limit (sīmā), they have the synonym रोदसी (*rodasī*). So the doubt arises naturally that the epithet उर्वी (*urvī*), which shows wide extent, cannot suit a world that is limited and bound. The Nirukta-author has read the word उर्वी (*urvī*) among the names of the earth and again among the names of "heaven and earth" (Ni. 1-1; 1-30). So it cannot be said that there is any incongruity here. Since the word रोदसी (*rodasī*) is here a synonym of heaven and earth, उर्वी (*urvī*) must be taken to mean "extended". It is a very meaningful word for indicating greatness and extent.

अयं मे पीत उदियर्ति वाचमयं मनीषामुशतीमजीगः । अयं षळुर्वीरमिमीत धीरो न याभ्यो भुवनं कच्चनारे ॥ (*ayaṃ me pīta udiyarti vācamayaṃ manīṣāmuśatīmajīgaḥ | ayaṃ ṣaḷurvīramimīta dhīro na yābhyo bhuvanaṃ kaccanāre ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-3)

This King Soma has created the six Urvīs; no region in the world lies beyond these Urvīs. These six are all-pervading. When this is said, which are these six Urvīs? They are the earth, the heavenly world, day, night, the waters and the plants. How? In the Śatapatha mantra

षण्मोर्वीर्गंहसस्पांत्वग्निश्च पृथिवी चापश्च वाजश्च रात्रिश्चेता मा देवताः (*ṣaṇmorvīrgaṃhasaspāṃtvagniśca pṛthivī cāpaśca vājaśca rātriścetā mā devatāḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 1-5-1-22)

there is an enumeration of which these Urvīs are. On this basis Sāyaṇa quoted this Brāhmaṇa sentence and explained as stated above. The same is continued and explained in the Ṛk-saṃhitā too; each Urvī is described with an epithet.

अयं स यो वरिमाणं पृथिव्या वर्षाणं दिवो अकृणोदयं सः । अयं पीयूषं त्रिसृषु प्रवत्सु सोमो दाधारोर्वं १ तरिक्षं ॥ अयं विदच्चित्रदृशीकमर्णः शुक्रसद्मनामुषसामनीके। अयं महान्महता स्यंभनेनोद्द्यामस्तभ्नाद्वषभो मरुत्वान् ॥ (*ayaṃ sa yo varimāṇaṃ pṛthivyā varṣāṇaṃ divo akṛṇodayaṃ saḥ | ayaṃ pīyūṣaṃ trisṛṣu pravatsu somo dādhārorvaṃ 1 tarikṣaṃ ‖ ayaṃ vidaccitradṛśīkamarṇaḥ śukrasadmanāmuṣasāmanīke | ayaṃ mahānmahatā syaṃbhanenoddyāmastabhnādvaṣabho marutvān ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-4, 5)

This Soma made the extent of the earth still greater; he increased the height of the heavenly world; he caused the three kinds of plants to spread throughout the universe; he increased the very extended atmosphere; he lit the world-attracting light of the sun endlessly; likewise he caused the middle world to become extended; and so on: the extension of all the worlds indicated by the word उर्वी (*urvī*) is described. Besides:

आ यः पप्र जायमान उर्वी दूरेदृशा भासा कृष्णाध्वा । (*ā yaḥ papra jāyamāna urvī dūredṛśā bhāsā kṛṣṇādhvā |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-10-4)

Agni, whose path is black, as soon as he was born pervaded the very extended Urvīs, that is, all of heaven and earth. Here the word Urvī is a synonym for heaven and earth only; or it may be a synonym for the earth alone. For example:

उर्वाः पदो नि दधाति सानौ रिंहत्योधो अरुषासो अस्य ॥ (*urvāḥ pado ni dadhāti sānau riṃhatyodho aruṣāso asya ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-146-2)

Agni sets his foot on the altar of the earth, very extended and high like a peak; so here the word Urvī indicates the earth alone.

Thus, when the word Urvī indicates endless extension, is this epithet fitting for Rodasī, which has a fixed limit? Here it may be said that the epithet is entirely proper.

How? The etymology विरोधनाद्रोदसी (*virodhanādrodasī*) can be given only in one context; the pervasiveness to be indicated by the word रोदसी (*rodasī*) is itself well known. With this purport, when describing the nature of the Aśvin deities too (?), because this pervasiveness exists, identity of the Aśvin deities with heaven and earth is stated.[?] 166

अथ यदश्विनावितीमे ह वै द्यावापृथिवी प्रत्यक्षमश्विनाविमे हीदग्ंसर्वमाश्नुनातां पुष्करस्रजावित्यग्निरेवास्यै पुष्करमादित्योऽमुष्यै (*atha yadaśvināvitīme ha vai dyāvāpṛthivī pratyakṣamaśvināvime hīdagṃsarvamāśnunātāṃ puṣkarasrajāvityagnirevāsyai puṣkaramādityo 'muṣyai*) (Śa. Brā. 4-1-5-16)

The Aśvin deities are directly manifest in this very form of heaven and earth. Because they have a nature that pervades every region, they have this name. They are called Puṣkara-srajas. Agni and Āditya are these Puṣkaras: Agni is the lotus (puṣkara) of the earth, Āditya that of the heavenly world.

शौर्णवाभोः दृच्छेत्वस्मिन् अश्विनौ मन्यते स्तुता । अहोरात्रौ च तावेव स्यातां तावेन रोदसी ॥ (*śaurṇavābhoḥ dṛcchetvasmin aśvinau manyate stutā | ahorātrau ca tāveva syātāṃ tāvena rodasī ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 7-126)

An opinion that this very heaven and earth, well known as Rodasī, are also well known as the Aśvin deities has been cited in the Bṛhaddevatā and other works. It is because of this attribute of pervasiveness that the name arises; therefore the epithet उर्वी (*urvī*) is proper.

The word रोदसी (*rodasī*) is used in the dual, but in some places it is also used in the singular. In those contexts it is not easy to say definitely what it means. In some cases the word occurs in one and the same mantra in both the first half and the second half; then a different meaning has to be given for each occurrence. For example:

इदुग्राः शवसा धृष्णुषेणा उभे युजंत रोदसी सुमेके! अध स्मैषु रोदसी स्वशोचिरामवत्सु तस्थौ न रोकः ॥ (*idugrāḥ śavasā dhṛṣṇuṣeṇā ubhe yujaṃta rodasī sumeke ! adha smaiṣu rodasī svaśocirāmavatsu tasthau na rokaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-66-6)

This mantra praises the Maruts. The meaning of the first sentence is that these Maruts yoke both heaven and earth; and the meaning of the second sentence is that Rodasī unites her radiance in these Maruts. But who is this Rodasī? Sāyaṇa has explained it as the middle speech (mādhyamikā vāk). One view is that this Rodasī is the wife of Rudra.

Another view is that she is the wife of the Maruts. "Wife of Rudra" means the mother of the Maruts. Rudra is Vāyu. This wife of Vāyu is the middle speech. The radiance in the form of lightning in that speech, joined with thunder, is called Rodasī. Supporting this very view:

रोदसी देवपत्नीनां अथर्वांगिरसे यथा (*rodasī devapatnīnāṃ atharvāṃgirase yathā*) (Bṛ. De. 2-143)

According to the Atharvāṅgirasa view, Rodasī is one of the wives of the gods: here is an example with the singular used. Even in such places, since the attribute of pervasiveness is present, the epithet उर्वी (*urvī*) is natural. In the present mantra the meaning is: heaven and earth, very extended and all-pervading.

सवितुः (*savituḥ*)—सवाय (*savāya*)—these two words also describe the nature of Savitṛ. Because he is the impeller of the world, the impelling function of the deity known by the word Savitṛ is described by these words. This attribute of Savitṛ will be explained further on. Mitra and Varuṇa, and heaven and earth, though they are purifiers of the world, maintainers of the world's order, givers of wealth and possessed of the highest greatness, all have their activity accomplished only by the impulsion of this Savitṛ: this is the purport of the description.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रिरु॑त्त॒मा दू॒णशा॑ रोच॒नानि॒ त्रयो॑ राज॒न्त्यसु॑रस्य वी॒राः ।
ऋ॒तावा॑न इषि॒रा दू॒ळभा॑स॒स्त्रिरा दि॒वो वि॒दथे॑ सन्तु दे॒वाः ॥ ८ ॥

> *triruttamā dūṇaśā rocanāni trayo rājantyasurasya vīrāḥ |*
> *ṛtāvāna iṣirā dūḷabhāsastrirā divo vidathe santu devāḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रिः । उत्तमा । दुःनशा । रोचनानि । त्रयः । राजंति । असुरस्य । वीराः ।
> ऋतवानः । इषिराः । दुःदभासः । त्रिः । आ । दिवः । विदथे । संतु । देवाः ॥ ८ ॥

> *triḥ | uttamā | duḥnaśā | rocanāni | trayaḥ | rājaṃti | asurasya | vīrāḥ |*
> *ṛtavānaḥ | iṣirāḥ | duḥdabhāsaḥ | triḥ | ā | divaḥ | vidathe | saṃtu | devāḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> दूणशा दुर्नशा केनापि विनाशयितुमशक्यानि रोचनानि दीप्यमानानि त्रिस्त्रिण्यंतमानि स्थानानि संति । एतेषु त्रिषु स्थानेष्टसुरस्य । अस्यति क्षिपति सर्वमित्यसुरः कालात्मा संवत्सरः । तस्य वीराः पुत्रास्त्रयोऽग्नि वायुसूर्यरूपा राजंति शोभंते । तानेव विशिनष्टि । ऋतावानः । ऋतं सत्यभूतमग्निहोत्रादिकं कर्म

> *dūṇaśā durnaśā kenāpi vināśayitumaśakyāni rocanāni dīpyamānāni tristriṇyaṃtamāni sthānāni saṃti | eteṣu triṣu sthāneṣṭasurasya | asyati kṣipati sarvamityasuraḥ*
> *kālātmā saṃvatsaraḥ | tasya vīrāḥ putrāstrayo 'gni vāyusūryarūpā rājaṃti*
> *śobhaṃte | tāneva viśinaṣṭi | ṛtāvānaḥ | ṛtaṃ satyabhūtamagnihotrādikaṃ karma*

> तद्वंतः । इषिरा यज्ञार्थं शीघ्रगतिमंतो दूळभासो दुर्दभासः केनापि स्वतेजसा तिरस्कर्तुमशक्या एते सर्वे देवा विदथेऽस्मदीये यज्ञे दिवोऽह्नः संबंधिषु त्रिस्त्रिषु सवनेष्वा संतु । समंताद्यजनीयतया भवंतु ॥ उत्तमा । उत्तमशश्वत्तमौ सर्वत्रेत्युंभादिषु पाठादंतोदात्तत्वं । दूणशा । नशेः कृच्छार्थे खल् । दुरो दाशनाशदभेषूत्वं वक्तव्यमिति रेफस्योत्वं । उत्तरपदादेः ष्टुत्वं । लित्स्वरः । दूळभासः । पूर्ववदुत्वष्टुत्वे ॥

> *tadvaṃtaḥ | iṣirā yajñārthaṃ śīghragatimaṃto dūḷabhāso durdabhāsaḥ kenāpi svatejasā tiraskartumaśakyā ete sarve devā vidathe 'smadīye yajñe divo 'hnaḥ saṃbaṃdhiṣu*
> *tristriṣu savaneṣvā saṃtu | samaṃtādyajanīyatayā bhavaṃtu ‖ uttamā | uttamaśaśvattamau*
> *sarvatretyuṃbhādiṣu pāṭhādaṃtodāttatvaṃ | dūṇaśā | naśeḥ kṛcchārthe khal | duro*
> *dāśanāśadabheṣūtvaṃ vaktavyamiti rephasyotvaṃ | uttarapadādeḥ ṣṭutvaṃ | litsvaraḥ |*
> *dūḷabhāsaḥ | pūrvavadutvaṣṭutve ‖*

Summary

दूणशा (*dūṇaśā*) is दुर्नशा (*durnaśā*): the bright (रोचनानि (*rocanāni*), shining) places, that cannot be destroyed by anyone, are three in number, the highest. In these three places there are the sons (वीराः (*vīrāḥ*)) of the Asura. Asura is he who throws out (अस्यति (*asyati*)) everything: the year, whose nature is Time. His three sons, in the forms of Agni, Vāyu and Sūrya, shine. He now qualifies them: ऋतावानः (*ṛtāvānaḥ*); ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*) is the rite such as the Agnihotra, which is true (the text breaks off here and continues on the next page).

(Continuing) Those who possess it (the ṛta). इषिरा (*iṣirā*): swift-moving for the sacrifice. दूळभासः (*dūḷabhāsaḥ*) is दुर्दभासः (*durdabhāsaḥ*): that cannot be overcome by anyone with his own radiance. May all these deities be present at our sacrifice (विदथे (*vidathe*)), in each of the three libations belonging to the day (दिवः (*divaḥ*)): that is, may they be there on all sides as worthy of worship. (The rest of the block is grammar.)

Word-to-word meaning

- दूणशा (*dūṇaśā*)—beyond destruction
- रोचनानि (*rocanāni*)—shining
- उत्तमा त्रिः (*uttamā triḥ*)—there are three highest places (in these places)
- असुरस्य (*asurasya*)—of the year, whose nature is time
- वीराः त्रयः (*vīrāḥ trayaḥ*)—the three sons in the forms of Agni, Vāyu and Sūrya
- राजंति (*rājaṃti*)—shine
- ऋतावानः (*ṛtāvānaḥ*)—those whose rite is of the nature of truth
- इषिरः (*iṣiraḥ*)—swift-moving for the sacrifice
- दूळभासः (*dūḷabhāsaḥ*)—those whose radiance cannot be checked
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—the deities
- विदथे (*vidathe*)—in the sacrifices
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of each day
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—also at the time of the three libations
- आ संतु (*ā saṃtu*)—may they come as worthy of worship and sit

Gist

There are three highest places, beyond destruction and shining. In these places Agni, Vāyu and Sūrya, the sons in form of the year whose nature is time, shine. May the deities, whose rite is of the nature of truth, who are swift-moving for the sacrifice and whose radiance cannot be checked, come in the sacrifices, at the times of the three libations of each day too, as worthy of worship, and sit.

English translation

Three are the excellent uninjurable bright regions, three scions of the powerful (year) are shining; practisers of truth, quick-moving of sur- passing radiance: may the deities be present thrice daily at the sacrifice.

Special Topics

In the present mantra the three worlds beginning with the earth, and the greatness of the presiding deities of the three worlds, Agni and the others, are praised. To make known the nature of the three worlds indicated by त्रिः (*triḥ*) there are three epithets: दूणशा (*dūṇaśā*), रोचनानि (*rocanāni*), उत्तमा (*uttamā*). The bhāṣya does not specify which the highest places are. But वीराः त्रयः (*vīrāḥ trayaḥ*) must be understood as the worlds of Agni, Vāyu and heaven. Ordinarily these worlds are often specified by epithets that show their individual peculiarity.

For example: उर्वि (*urvi*), पृथिवी (*pṛthivī*), अपरा (*aparā*) and the like show the extent of the earth; भूमिः (*bhūmiḥ*) shows that the earth is the place of origin for beings; मही (*mahī*), उत्ताना (*uttānā*) and the like show its height. In many places the earth is indicated merely by the word इदं (*idaṃ*); in such contexts it means what is distinct from the worlds above. Epithets such as दिवि (*divi*), रोचन (*rocana*), व्योम (*vyoma*) describe the radiance of the atmosphere; सानु (*sānu*), विष्टप (*viṣṭapa*), पृष्ठ (*pṛṣṭha*) indicate its height. In some places it is even hard to say what the difference between the atmosphere and the heavenly world is. For example, if there is a difference between atmosphere and heaven (द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)), it is hard to say whether the word रोदसी (*rodasī*) means earth and atmosphere or heaven and earth.

The epithet or synonym रजस् (*rajas*) often indicates the atmosphere. But, just as in the present Ṛk there is the epithet उत्तमा (*uttamā*), रजस् (*rajas*) too is a word that can indicate the three worlds. In such contexts the epithets तृतीय (*tṛtīya*), उत्तम (*uttama*), परम (*parama*) tell which of the three worlds is meant; but there too one must say according to the context. For example:

सहस्रधारेव ता असश्च तस्य तीये संतु रजसि प्रजावतीः । (*sahasradhāreva tā asaśca tasya tīye saṃtu rajasi prajāvatīḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-74-6)

Here तृतीये रजसि (*tṛtīye rajasi*) is explained as heaven; one may say the heavenly world.

समुद्रे त्वा नृमणा अप्पं १ तर्नृचक्षा ईधे दिवो अग्न ऊधन् । तृतीये त्वा रजसि तस्थिवांसमपामुपस्थे महिषा अवर्धन् ॥ (*samudre tvā nṛmaṇā appaṃ 1 tarnṛcakṣā īdhe divo agna ūdhan | tṛtīye tvā rajasi tasthivāṃsamapāmupasthe mahiṣā avardhan ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-45-3)

Here there is the word दिवः (*divaḥ*) indicating the heavenly world. In this context तृतीये रजसि (*tṛtīye rajasi*) is explained as the atmosphere. The word तृतीय (*tṛtīya*) is not explained as "the third world" but explained otherwise. In उतेदमुत्तमं रजः (*utedamuttamaṃ rajaḥ*) (9-22-5) the "highest region" is understood as the heavenly world.

तिस्रो द्यावो निहिता अंतरस्मिंस्तिस्रो भूमीरुपराः षड्विधानाः । गृत्सो राजा वरुणश्चक्र एतं दिवि प्रेंखं हिरण्ययं शुभे कं ॥ (*tisro dyāvo nihitā aṃtarasmiṃstisro bhūmīruparāḥ ṣaḍvidhānāḥ | gṛtso rājā varuṇaścakra etaṃ divi preṃkhaṃ hiraṇyayaṃ śubhe kaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-87-5)

Here, as stated earlier in the mantra त्रिपाजस्यः (*tripājasyaḥ*) of the present sūkta (3-56-3), the heavenly world and the earth are shown as threefold by तिस्रः द्यावः (*tisraḥ dyāvaḥ*) and तिस्रः भूमीः (*tisraḥ bhūmīḥ*), and the atmosphere is stated in the singular. It is also a special feature that दिवि (*divi*) is used as a synonym of the atmosphere.

त्रिरश्विना सिंधुभिः सप्तमातृभिस्त्रय आहवास्त्रेधा हविष्कृतं । तिस्रः पृथिवीरुपरि प्रवा दिवो नाकं रक्षेथे द्युभिरक्तुभिर्हितं ॥ (*triraśvinā siṃdhubhiḥ saptamātṛbhistraya āhavāstredhā haviṣkṛtaṃ | tisraḥ pṛthivīrupari pravā divo nākaṃ rakṣethe dyubhiraktubhirhitaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-34-8)

Here the word नाक (*nāka*) indicates the fourth world. "पृथिव्यादिलोकेभ्यः ऊर्ध्वं आदित्यलोकं (*pṛthivyādilokebhyaḥ ūrdhvaṃ ādityalokaṃ*)": it is explained as the world of Āditya lying above the three worlds beginning with the earth. In many places the fourth world is described, as shown by the contexts. For example:

चमूषच्छेनः शकुनो विभृत्वा गोविंदुर्द्रप्स आयुधानि बिभ्रत् । अपामूर्मिं सचमानः समुद्रं तुरीयं धाम महिषो विवक्ति ॥ (*camūṣacchenaḥ śakuno vibhṛtvā goviṃdurdrapsa āyudhāni bibhrat | apāmūrmiṃ sacamānaḥ samudraṃ turīyaṃ dhāma mahiṣo vivakti ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-96-19)

King Soma, having traversed the entire atmosphere, then entered the fourth abode (तुरीयधाम (*turīyadhāma*)) and moved about there: thus it is made known that the fourth world is beyond the well-known three worlds, and that it is the world of Āditya. The greatness of this fourth world will be shown later when the Gāyatrī mantra is explained; here only its distinctness may be noted. Sāyaṇa here says तुरीयं चतुर्थं धाम चांद्रमसं स्थानं सेवते । सूरलोकस्योपरि चंद्रमसः लोकः विद्यते । (*turīyaṃ caturthaṃ dhāma cāṃdramasaṃ sthānaṃ sevate | sūralokasyopari caṃdramasaḥ lokaḥ vidyate |*), that is, that this fourth world is known as the world of the moon and is beyond the solar world. But that this fourth world is described as the world of Āditya in the Upaniṣads and other works may be examined later. Even where it says तिस्रः पृथिवीः त्रीणि रोचना (*tisraḥ pṛthivīḥ trīṇi rocanā*), the meaning has to be given according to the context.

त्रिरुत्तराणि पप्रतुर्वरुणस्य ध्रुवं सदः स सप्तानामिरज्यति नभंतामन्यकेसमे । (*triruttarāṇi papraturvaruṇasya dhruvaṃ sadaḥ sa saptānāmirajyati nabhaṃtāmanyake same |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-41-9)

Here it is said that the rays of Varuṇa pervaded not only the three earths but, passing beyond them, the three highest worlds (उत्तराणि त्रिः (*uttarāṇi triḥ*)): a threefold world beyond the worlds beginning with the earth. Descriptions such as तिस्रः परावतो दिवः (*tisraḥ parāvato divaḥ*) (8-5 8) indicate the same point.[?167]. One of the mantras that give room for disagreement may be taken as an example and examined.

तिस्रो द्यावः सवितुर्दा उपस्था एका यमस्य भुवने विराषाट् । आणिं न रथ्यममृताधि तस्थुरिह ब्रवीतु य उ तच्छिकेतत् ॥ (*tisro dyāvaḥ saviturdā upasthā ekā yamasya bhuvane virāṣāṭ | āṇiṃ na rathyamamṛtādhi tasthuriha bravītu ya u tacchiketat ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-35-6)

Of the three kinds of heavenly worlds, two belong to Savitṛ and one to Yama. Just as all the parts of a chariot rest on the linchpin and are joined depending on it, all the deathless worlds on this (the text breaks off here and the next window continues it).

…rest upon the world of Savitṛ alone. In Mādhava's commentary on the Ṛgveda, and in Sāyaṇa's commentary as well, these three worlds are explained as earth, atmosphere and heaven; of these, earth and heaven belong to Savitṛ, and the atmosphere is the world of Yama. Veṅkaṭamādhava, however, has explained that all three are varieties of the heavenly world, and that Agni and Savitṛ are the presiding deities of them. Skandasvāmin holds that either of these two opinions may be accepted.

There is a doubt also about the true meaning of तद्विष्णोः परमं पदं (*tadviṣṇoḥ paramaṃ padaṃ*), तुरीयं धाम (*turīyaṃ dhāma*) and the like. Yāska regards Viṣṇu as a deity of the heavenly region. But if the explanation in the Ṛksaṃhitā is examined, it appears that this heavenly region lies beyond the three worlds. In तिस्रो द्यावः (*tisro dyāvaḥ*), one is the seat of Soma and the Ṛbhus; the second is the world of Sūra; the third is the world of Āditya. That is the highest step of Viṣṇu.

In the present verse, even when त्रिः उत्तमा रोचना (*triḥ uttamā rocanā*) is taken as "three highest places", there is room for doubt. But since वीराः त्रयः (*vīrāḥ trayaḥ*) has been explained as Agni, Vāyu and Āditya, on that basis one has to say: earth, atmosphere and heaven.

दूणशा (*dūṇaśā*) may be explained as "that which is without destruction"; or it may also be explained as "that which cannot be obtained easily".

असुरस्य (*asurasya*)—अस्यति क्षिपति सर्वमित्यसुरः । कालात्मा संवत्सरः । (*asyati kṣipati sarvamityasuraḥ | kālātmā saṃvatsaraḥ |*) Here only one aspect of the year is indicated: the year in the form of Time, which holds everything under its control. As the year is the cause of creation and growth, so it is the cause of decay. As explained before, here too Prajāpati, the presiding deity of the year, may be what is meant.

प्रजापतिर्लोकानभ्यतपत्तेषां तप्यमानानां रसान्प्रावृहदग्निं पृथिव्या वायुमंतरिक्षादादित्यं दिवः ॥ (*prajāpatirlokānabhyatapatteṣāṃ tapyamānānāṃ rasānprāvṛhadagniṃ pṛthivyā vāyumaṃtarikṣādādityaṃ divaḥ* ‖) (Bhā. U. 4-17-1)[?168]

Prajāpati meditated on the essence of the three worlds, drew out their sap and spread it forth. From the earth he caused Agni to shine, from the atmosphere Vāyu, from heaven Āditya. Since it is thus described that from the three worlds spoken of in the present Ṛk as रोचना त्रिः (*rocanā triḥ*) he caused three excellent deities to shine, here also असुरस्य (*asurasya*) may be said to mean Prajāpati in the form of the year.

The word asura denotes a special power; this power may be nourishing or it may be destroying. Although the special meanings of this word were given earlier, in the present context one must determine its import and examine its etymology closely, in order to know of which principle, and of what forms of power, this word shows.

Its etymology must be understood in detail.

असुरा असुरताः स्थानेष्वस्ताः स्थानेभ्य इति वा । अपि वा असुरिति प्राणनाम अस्तः शरीरे भवति तेन तद्वंतः ॥ (*asurā asuratāḥ sthāneṣvastāḥ sthānebhya iti vā | api vā asuriti prāṇanāma astaḥ śarīre bhavati tena tadvaṃtaḥ ‖*) (Ni. 3-8)

The rākṣasas are well known by the name asura because they are always satisfied with evil deeds. Or they may be asuras because they were cast out and thrust aside by the gods. Or the word asu may be a synonym of breath. Or there is the division that the gods are suras, because they were created by su, that is, by right conduct (sad-dharma), and the rākṣasas are a-suras, created by wrong conduct (a-su). For the present this explanation is irrelevant. The mantras of the preceding sūkta show what quality is indicated by the use of the word asura in the present context. महद्देवानामसुरत्वमेकं (*mahaddevānāmasuratvamekaṃ*) is the last pāda of every mantra of the preceding sūkta. In these places also, as in the etymology given in the present Ṛk, अस्यति क्षिपति सर्वानित्यसुरः प्रबलः । तस्य भावः असुरत्वं प्राबल्यं । महदैश्वर्यं । (*asyati kṣipati sarvānityasuraḥ prabalaḥ | tasya bhāvaḥ asuratvaṃ prābalyaṃ | mahadaiśvaryaṃ |*) is the explanation; the meaning is "lordship possessed of the power to subdue enemies". Therefore, when the asura-hood of individual gods has so much power, it need not be said that the asura-hood of Prajāpati, who is the lord of all the gods, is that which governs the universe. Because of this power of governing the universe, Prajāpati, or the Lord in the form of Time, is the one denoted by the word asura. In this governing of the universe, besides the work of mere accomplishing, the power that gives life to the whole universe is also manifested. Describing this power, there is in Ṛks such as

वि सुपर्णो अंतरिक्षाण्यख्यद्भभीरवेपाः असुरः सुनीथः (*vi suparṇo aṃtarikṣāṇyakhyaddhabhīravepāḥ asuraḥ sunīthaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-35-7)

a description of the god who gives life to the universe. Since it is praised in the Brāhmaṇas and elsewhere that सर्वेषां भूतानां प्राणानादायोदेति (*sarvèṣāṃ bhūtānāṃ prāṇānādāyodeti*) (Tai. Ā. 1-14-1)—Āditya is the giver of life to all beings—it is understood from the quoted mantra that the word asura here is an epithet of Āditya, who has that same power. Moreover, in places such as जनानां यो असुरो विधर्ता (*janānāṃ yo asuro vidhartā*) (7-56-24) the word is also explained as "possessed of wisdom". Thus a quality joined with various powers is described by the word asura. Since all powers—the power of creation, the power of destruction, the power of governing the universe and so on—are centred in Prajāpati in the form of Time, in the present context Prajāpati, the father of the whole universe including gods and men, may be the one denoted by the word asura. Since Prajāpati, Time and the year are synonyms in many contexts, whichever of them is used, there is no difference in the principle.

एष वै मृत्युरत्यंवत्सरः । एष हि मर्त्यानामहोरात्राभ्यामायुः क्षिणोत्यथ म्रियंते तस्मादेष एव मृत्युः स यो हैतं मृत्युगं् संवत्सरं वेद .... तस्मादेष एवांतकः स यो हैतमंतकं मृत्युगं् संवत्सरं वेद न हास्यैष.... .... । ते देवाः एतस्मादंतकान्मै त्र्योः संवत्सरात्पजापतेर्बिभियां चक्रुः ॥ (*eṣa vai mṛtyuratyaṃvatsaraḥ | eṣa hi martyānāmahorātrābhyāmāyuḥ kṣiṇotyatha mriyaṃte tasmādeṣa eva mṛtyuḥ sa yo haitaṃ mṛtyugṃ saṃvatsaraṃ veda .... tasmādeṣa evāṃtakaḥ sa yo haitamaṃtakaṃ mṛtyugṃ saṃvatsaraṃ veda na hāsyaiṣa.... .... | te devāḥ etasmādaṃtakānmai tryoḥ saṃvatsarātpajāpaterbibhiyāṃ cakruḥ ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1C-4-3-1-3)[?169]

The great principle which, having attained asura-hood, holds the universe under its control by that power, and which Sāyaṇa has explained as अस्यति क्षिपति सर्वं (*asyati kṣipati sarvaṃ*)—कालात्मा संवत्सरः (*kālātmā saṃvatsaraḥ*), that great principle of the year is Prajāpati. As it is the source of the creation of the universe, so it is the source of its destruction. This year is Death. For human and other beings it makes life wear away (pass away) in the form of days and nights. It causes death to all. Therefore this year, in the form of Time, is the ender of all. It is described that even the gods, knowing the nature of this Prajāpati in the form of the year as the ender, became afraid.

Therefore, प्रजापतिर्वा इदमग्र आसीत् । स इमांस्त्रीन् लोकानभिततताप । तेभ्यस्तप्तेभ्यस्त्रिणि ज्योतीग्ष्यजायंताग्निर्योऽयं पवते सूरः ॥ (*prajāpatirvā idamagra āsīt | sa imāṃstrīn lokānabhitatāpa | tebhyastaptebhyastriṇi jyotīgṣyajāyaṃtāgniryo 'yaṃ pavate sūraḥ* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 11-5 8-2)[?170] — The Prajāpati who is described thus: from Prajāpati, who existed before the creation of the universe, the three worlds beginning with earth were created, and from them the three luminous forms Agni, Vāyu and Āditya were created; who is described as the year that creates, and as Time, which though destroying is in the form of the year, and as the ender—the three sons of that Prajāpati, Agni, Vāyu and Āditya, in the form of three lights, are described in the present Ṛk as त्रयः वीराः (*trayaḥ vīrāḥ*).

ऋतावानः (*ṛtāvānaḥ*)—those who maintain the truth of the three worlds. Agni maintains the rules of sacrifice and the like on earth and so keeps truth in being. In the same way Vāyu, in the form of the life-breath of the universe, maintains the truth of the atmosphere, the giving of rain and so on. Āditya, being lord of these two worlds, maintains the truth of all the worlds; therefore the epithet ऋतावानः (*ṛtāvānaḥ*) applies to all together.

दूळभासः (*dūḷabhāsaḥ*)—दुःदभासः (*duḥdabhāsaḥ*): a radiance that no one has the power to restrain. By this epithet is described the nature of the radiances of Āditya, which are unlike others, supernatural, unobstructed and all-pervading.

Sūkta 57 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> प्र मे विविक्वानिति षड्टचं चतुर्थं सूक्तं । विश्वामित्र ऋषिः । तिष्टप् छंदः ।
> विश्वे देवा देवता । अत्रानुक्रमणिका । प्र मे षळिति । सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥
> अनुवादवु—प्र मे विविक्वान् ऎंब ई सूक्तवु ऐदनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि नाल्कनॆय
> सूक्तवु. इदरल्लि आरु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्के विश्वामित्रनु ऋषियु ; विश्वेदेवतॆगळु
> देवतॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—प्र मे षट् ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. सूक्तद
> विनियोगवु लैंगिकवु.
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—५७
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—५ ॥ सूक्त—५७ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—२ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—६ ॥
> ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ॥
> देवता—विश्वे देवाः ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *pra me vivikvāniti ṣaḍṛcaṃ caturthaṃ sūktaṃ | viśvāmitra ṛṣiḥ | tiṣṭap chaṃdaḥ |*
> *viśve devā devatā | atrānukramaṇikā | pra me ṣaḷiti | sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ‖*
> *anuvādavu—pra me vivikvān èṃba ī sūktavu aidanèya anuvākadalli nālkanèya*
> *sūktavu. idaralli āru ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè viśvāmitranu ṛṣiyu ; viśvedevatègaḷu*
> *devatèyu ; triṣṭup chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli—pra me ṣaṭ èṃdu heḷiruvudu. sūktada*
> *viniyogavu laiṃgikavu.*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—57*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—5 ‖ sūkta—57 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—2 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—6 ‖*

> *ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ ‖*
> *devatā—viśve devāḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning प्र मे विविक्वान् (*pra me vivikvān*) is the fourth sūkta (of the fifth anuvāka), of six Ṛks. The seer is Viśvāmitra, the deity the Viśvedevas, the metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā says प्र मे षळिति (*pra me ṣaḷiti*). The application (viniyoga) of the sūkta is by indication (liṅga). The Kannada gives: Maṇḍala 3, Anuvāka 5, Sūkta 57; Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 4, Varga 2; number of Ṛks in the sūkta 6.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र मे॑ विवि॒क्वाँ अ॑विदन्मनी॒षां धे॒नुं चर॑न्ती॒ं प्रयु॑ता॒मगो॑पाम् ।
स॒द्यश्चि॒द्या दु॑दु॒हे भूरि॑ धा॒सेरिन्द्र॒स्तद॒ग्निः प॑नि॒तारो॑ अस्याः ॥ १ ॥

> *pra me vivikvā~ avidanmanīṣāṃ dhenuṃ carantīṃ prayutāmagopām |*
> *sadyaścidyā duduhe bhūri dhāserindrastadagniḥ panitāro asyāḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । मे । विविक्षान् । अविदत् । मनीषां । धेनुं । चरंतीं । प्रयुतां ।
> अगोपां ।
> सद्यः । चित् । आ । दुदुहे । भूरि । धासेः । इंद्रः । तत् । अग्निः । पनितारः । अ स्याः ॥

> *pra | me | vivikṣān | avidat | manīṣāṃ | dhenuṃ | caraṃtīṃ |*
> *prayutāṃ |*
> *agopāṃ |*
> *sadyaḥ | cit | ā | duduhe | bhūri | dhāseḥ | iṃdraḥ | tat | agniḥ |*
> *panitāraḥ | a syāḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विविक्वान्वेकवानिंद्रोग्निर्वा मे मम मनीषां देवताविषयां स्तुतिं
> प्राविदत् । प्रकर्षण जानातु । तत्र दृष्टांतः । चरंतीं यवस इतस्ततो गच्छंतीं
> प्रयुतां पृथग्भूतामेकाकिनीमगोपां गोप्तृरहितां यथाकामं चरंतीं
> धेनुं नवसूतिकां गामिव देवतानां प्रीणयित्रीं स्तुतिमविददित्यन्वयः । या
> स्तुतिरूपा धेनुः सद्यश्चित्तदानीमेव धासेः । धारयति प्राणान् धीयते दीयतेर्थिभ्य इति वा
> धासिरन्नं । कर्मणि षष्ठी । भूरि बह्वन्नमपेक्षितं फलं दुदुहे दुग्धे
> इंद्रोग्निरन्ये च देवा अस्याः स्तुतिरूपाया धेनोस्तत्तस्यान्नभूतस्य पयसः
> पनितारः स्तोतारो भवंति । यद्वा । इंद्राग्नी स्तोतारो वयं चास्या धेनोस्तत्पयः प्राप्नुमः ॥
> विविक्वान् ! विचिर् पृथग्भाव इत्यस्य क्वसौ रूपं । अविदत् । विद
> ज्ञान इत्यस्य लजि बहुलं छंदसीति शः । दुदुहे । दुह प्रपूरण इत्यस्य लिटि रूपं ।
> यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । पनितारः । पन स्तुतावित्यस्य तृचि रूपं ॥

> *vivikvānvekavāniṃdrognirvā me mama manīṣāṃ devatāviṣayāṃ stutiṃ*
> *prāvidat | prakarṣaṇa jānātu | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | caraṃtīṃ yavasa itastato gacchaṃtīṃ*
> *prayutāṃ pṛthagbhūtāmekākinīmagopāṃ goptṛrahitāṃ yathākāmaṃ caraṃtīṃ*
> *dhenuṃ navasūtikāṃ gāmiva devatānāṃ prīṇayitrīṃ stutimavidadityanvayaḥ | yā*
> *stutirūpā dhenuḥ sadyaścittadānīmeva dhāseḥ | dhārayati prāṇān dhīyate dīyaterthibhya iti vā dhāsirannaṃ | karmaṇi ṣaṣṭhī | bhūri bahvannamapekṣitaṃ phalaṃ duduhe dugdhe*
> *iṃdrogniranye ca devā asyāḥ stutirūpāyā dhenostattasyānnabhūtasya payasaḥ*
> *panitāraḥ stotāro bhavaṃti | yadvā | iṃdrāgnī stotāro vayaṃ cāsyā dhenostatpayaḥ prāpnumaḥ ‖ vivikvān ! vicir pṛthagbhāva ityasya kvasau rūpaṃ | avidat | vida*
> *jñāna ityasya laji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śaḥ | duduhe | duha prapūraṇa ityasya liṭi rūpaṃ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | panitāraḥ | pana stutāvityasya tṛci rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

Vivikvān, that is Indra or Agni, मे (*me*) "my" मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*) praise directed to the deities, let him know well (प्राविदत् (*prāvidat*)). The illustration: as one knows a cow that is चरंतीं (*caraṃtīṃ*) wandering hither and thither for fodder, प्रयुतां (*prayutāṃ*) separated, alone, अगोपां (*agopāṃ*) without a herdsman, roaming at will, a धेनुं (*dhenuṃ*) newly calved cow—so (let him know) the praise that gratifies the gods; this is the construction. The praise in the form of a cow that सद्यश्चित् (*sadyaścit*) at that very moment milks abundant धासेः (*dhāseḥ*): dhāsi is food, either because it sustains the life-breaths or because it is given to those who seek it; the genitive is in the sense of the object. भूरि (*bhūri*) abundant food, the desired fruit, it milks. Indra, Agni and the other gods are पनितारः (*panitāraḥ*), praisers, of the milk, that is of the food-like milk, of this cow in the form of praise. Or else: Indra and Agni are the praisers, and we obtain that milk of this cow. (The remainder of the block gives the grammar of vivikvān, avidat, duduhe and panitāraḥ.)

Word-to-word meaning

- या (*yā*)—which cow in the form of praise
- सद्यश्चित् (*sadyaścit*)—immediately
- धासेः (*dhāseḥ*)—food
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—abundantly
- दुदुहे (*duduhe*)—milks (such a one)
- मे (*me*)—my
- मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*)—the cow in the form of praise
- विविक्वान् (*vivikvān*)—Indra the discerning
- चरंतीं (*caraṃtīṃ*)—running while eating grass
- प्रयुतां (*prayutāṃ*)—solitary
- अगोपां (*agopāṃ*)—roaming freely without a cowherd
- धेनुं (*dhenuṃ*)—as one knows a cow
- प्र अविदत् (*pra avidat*)—may he know
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni (and the other gods also)
- अस्याः (*asyāḥ*)—of this cow in the form of praise
- पनितारः (*panitāraḥ*)—are the praisers

Gist

As one knows a cow that runs about for grass and roams alone at will without a cowherd, let the discerning Indra know my praise, which is like a cow and which yields abundant food. Indra, Agni and the other deities also are praisers of this cow in the form of praise.

English translation

May the discriminating Indra apprehend my glorification (of the gods), which is (free) as a milch cow, grazing alone, without a cowherd, one who is readily milked, yielding abundant nourishment, and of whom Agni and Indra (and we), are the commenders.

Special Topics

In this mantra praise is compared to a cow, and the quality common to the two is shown. Just as the protection of a cow that yields milk in plenty and satisfies its owner is necessary, so the same protection is necessary in the matter of praise; thus praise is extolled. The epithets used here to extol praise should be examined, and afterwards the power and the fruitfulness of praise should be considered.

In the present verse it is prayed that Indra and the others may know the cow in the form of praise. The word मनीषा (*manīṣā*) is used as a synonym of praise. This manīṣā is described as the giver of food. The word धासि (*dhāsi*) means food. There is a little distinctiveness in the use of this word.

धासेः (*dhāseḥ*)—this word is read among the names of food, धासिः इरा (*dhāsiḥ irā*) and so on (Ni. 2-7). It is derived from the root धेट् (*theṭ*) meaning "to drink"[?171], and gives the meaning of food in the form of oblation. Or it may also mean "that which sustains life"; the import is "that which makes one stand firm". To understand its import in detail, some examples should be examined.

कविं केतुं धासिं भानुमद्रेर्हिन्वंति शं राज्यं रोदस्योः । (*kaviṃ ketuṃ dhāsiṃ bhānumadrerhinvaṃti śaṃ rājyaṃ rodasyoḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-6-2)

Here the word is an epithet of Vaiśvānara Agni. The epithet धासिं (*dhāsiṃ*) is in the sense of one who lifts up and protects the praiser. Sāyaṇa has given the import: धासिं (*dhāsiṃ*)—धर्तारं (*dhartāraṃ*).

प्राक्तुभ्य इंद्रः प्र वृधो अहभ्यः प्रांतरिक्षात्प्र समुद्रस्य धासेः । प्र वातस्य प्रथसः प्र ज्यो अंतात्प्र सिंधुभ्यो रिरिचे प्र क्षितिभ्यः ॥ (*prāktubhya iṃdraḥ pra vṛdho ahabhyaḥ prāṃtarikṣātpra samudrasya dhāseḥ | pra vātasya prathasaḥ pra jyo aṃtātpra siṃdhubhyo ririce pra kṣitibhyaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-89-11)

Here this epithet is used to describe the growth of Indra. Indra is described as grown beyond heaven and earth. And since he is said to be grown beyond even the place that holds the sea, the greatness of Indra is understood. The word dhāsi means "that which holds". The place that holds the sea is utterly firm; the import is that Indra has grown beyond even that. In this manner the word is used in the sense of "holder".

The word *dhāsi* also occurs in passages such as महीं मित्रस्य वरुणस्य धासिं पृथुज्रयसे रीरधा सुवृक्तिं । (*mahīṃ mitrasya varuṇasya dhāsiṃ pṛthujrayase rīradhā suvṛktiṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-30-1). Although *dhāsi* means "food" in such places, food sustains life and strength, and for that reason "food" has *dhāsi* as a synonym. In the same way, in the present Ṛk the praise addressed to Indra and the others sustains the sacrificer's life, or gives him food. This is the purport.

Manīṣām: this word is commonly used as a synonym of "praise". The Nirukta reads it among the names of the wise (*manīṣī*). Some places in Sāyaṇa's commentary say that the explanation of *manīṣā* as *manasa īṣā* is acceptable. It can mean a distinguished talent or a power of imagination. This power, filled with devotion and moved by feeling, ripens in praise that takes the form of poetry. That is why the word is used as a synonym of praise. Its full sense is contained in the word used in the mantra quoted below:

मनीषिणः प्र भरध्वं मनीषां यथायथा मतयः संति नृणां । इंद्रं सत्यैरेरयामा कृतेभिः स हि वीरो गिर्वणस्युर्विदानः ॥ (*manīṣiṇaḥ pra bharadhvaṃ manīṣāṃ yathāyathā matayaḥ saṃti nṛṇāṃ | iṃdraṃ satyairerayāmā kṛtebhiḥ sa hi vīro girvaṇasyurvidānaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-111-1).

Here it says that the wise should compose a *manīṣā* addressed to Indra, and there is a coherence in this. According to whatever intellectual power and whatever capacity of imagination the human sacrificers have, they should compose their praise. The first word *manīṣiṇaḥ* means poets with such capacity; the second word *manīṣām* means the work of such poets, inspired by feeling. A work composed in address to the deities is known as praise. Thus:

पतंगो वाचं मनसा बिभर्ति तां गंधर्वोऽवदद्गर्भे अंतः । तां द्योतमानां स्वर्यं मनीषामृतस्य पदे कवयो निपांति ॥ (*pataṃgo vācaṃ manasā bibharti tāṃ gaṃdharvo 'vadadgarbhe aṃtaḥ | tāṃ dyotamānāṃ svaryaṃ manīṣāmṛtasya pade kavayo nipāṃti ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-77-2).

Here the word *manīṣām* has a very deep meaning. It is not merely mental talent. The principle of speech is indicated here: that which lies within the sun, which has the form of the three Vedas, which is of the nature of the Word-Brahman. *Manīṣām* is explained as मनसः ईशित्रिं (*manasaḥ īśitriṃ*). That is, the meaning may be given as that which has an independent movement of mind, free of dependence on another, and so on. In passages such as मनीषिणो मनसा पृच्छत (*manīṣiṇo manasā pṛcchata*) (10-85-4), "let the wise examine with inner vision", the word

manīṣi does not mean a principle grasped by the intellect alone, but the power of mind able to realise the supreme truth by inner vision. This power is inspired by a feeling of the nature of *samādhi*. A mere intellectual power without *samādhi* cannot grasp this truth.

कामस्तदग्रे समवर्तताधि मनसो रेतः प्रथमं यदासीत् । सतो बंधुमसति निरविंदन् हृदि प्रतीष्या कवयो मनीषा ॥ (*kāmastadagre samavartatādhi manaso retaḥ prathamaṃ yadāsīt | sato baṃdhumasati niraviṃdan hṛdi pratīṣyā kavayo manīṣā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-129-4).

In such mantras too, the word *manīṣā* indicates the power of the self able to grasp the laws of the world, such as the creation by the Lord. हृदि निरुद्दया बुद्ध्या (*hṛdi niruddayā buddhyā*): this world-principle can be reached only by the intellect concentrated in the heart in the form of *samādhi*. This is the purport. In the same way, in the contexts that give this word the meaning "praise", it must be understood as praise capable of knowing the principle of the Lord. Since this praise bestows every prosperity, its nature is described by धासेः दुदुहे (*dhāseḥ duduhe*): praise able to draw forth the wealth of food. The prayer is that Indra and the others may take note of our praise, so excellent and so able to know the supreme truth.

कस्ते मद इंद्र रंत्यो भूद्दुरो गिरो अभ्यु १ ग्रो वि धाव । कद्वाहो अर्वागुप मा मनीषा आ त्वा शक्यामुपमं राधो अन्नैः ॥ (*kaste mada iṃdra raṃtyo bhūdduro giro abhyu 1 gro vi dhāva | kadvāho arvāgupa mā manīṣā ā tvā śakyāmupamaṃ rādho annaiḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-29-3).

In this Ṛk also Sāyaṇa has said that the same view is indicated. He explains मनीषा सर्वार्थदर्शिनी प्रज्ञा, सर्वगुणग्राहिणी स्तुतिर्वा (*manīṣā sarvārthadarśinī prajñā, sarvaguṇagrāhiṇī stutirvā*) as a supernatural insight that shows the secret of all things, or praise that grasps all qualities.

This *manīṣā* is compared to a cow without a herdsman. The epithet *agopām* allows two meanings. First, "without rule", that is, independent. Independence here does not mean unrestrained. As the *Kāvyaprakāśa* describes the poet's independence, नियतिकृतिनियमरहितां ह्लादैकमयीमनस्य परतंत्रां (*niyatikṛtiniyamarahitāṃ hlādaikamayīmanasya parataṃtrāṃ*), one meaning is that the poet's talent that makes this praise is not bound by external rules; it is praise full of independent feeling and of the nature of *samādhi*. Or else, because of the epithet *agopām*, the need for protection may be shown. Just as a cow without a herdsman needs protection, the praises at hand also need the grace of the Lord. This is the purport. However much milk a cow without a herdsman may be able to give,

that ability is wasted; in the same way any power of a man who has not won the Lord's grace is useless. Another purport may therefore be given: that Indra and Agni should know the distinction of this praise and show favour.

Prayutām: just as two meanings can be given to the epithet *agopām*, the same is possible with the epithet *prayutām*. The root *yu* is used in both senses, "mixed" and "unmixed". *Prayuta* may mean "joined together", or "not joined to anything, solitary".

गावो यवं प्रयुता अर्यो अक्षन् ता अपश्यं सहगोपाश्चरंतीः । हवा इदर्यो अभितः समायन्कियदासु स्वपतिष्छंदयाते ॥ (*gāvo yavaṃ prayutā aryo akṣan tā apaśyaṃ sahagopāścaraṃtīḥ | havā idaryo abhitaḥ samāyankiyadāsu svapatiṣchaṃdayāte* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-27-8).

Here the scene of cows gathered together is described. For *prayutāḥ* the gloss is प्रकर्षण मिश्रिताः परस्परेण सह भूताः । (*prakarṣaṇa miśritāḥ parasparеṇa saha bhūtāḥ* |); the purport is that they have mingled with one another and are all crowded together. But in the present Ṛk this word stands together with the epithet *agopām*, so the purport is that the cow is solitary, not mixed with other cows, without a protector, and seeking the protection of the gods.

Panitāraḥ: this word is formed from the root *pan*, "to praise". The Nirukta authors read *panasyati* and *panāyate* among the names of the act of honouring. The word is used in the senses "worship", "extol", "show devotion". For example:

रथे तिष्ठन्नयति वाजिनः पुरो यत्रयत्र कामयते सुषारथिः । अभीशूनां महिमानं पनायत मनः पश्चादनु यच्छंति रश्मयः ॥ (*rathe tiṣṭhannayati vājinaḥ puro yatrayatra kāmayate suṣārathiḥ | abhīśūnāṃ mahimānaṃ panāyata manaḥ paścādanu yacchaṃti raśmayaḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-75-6).

Citing this Ṛk, they explain the context: the reins tied to the chariot, which hold the horses, are praised as most excellent, and then it is said, "O people, honour such reins." The Nirukta authors explain: हे जनाः अभीशूनां महिमानं पूजयत (*he janāḥ abhīśūnāṃ mahimānaṃ pūjayata*); the purport is "O men, worship these *abhīśu* (rein or rope)" (Ni. 9-6).

यदेव पनाय्क्यं कर्म तदेतदभिवदति । (*yadeva panāykyaṃ karma tadetadabhivadati* |) (Ai. Brā. 6-15). This sentence of the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa is explained as: the mantra recites that very act of Soma-drinking which is worthy of honour.

प्रवो धियो मंद्रयुवो विपन्युवः पनस्युवः संवसनेष्वक्रमुः । (*pravo dhiyo maṃdrayuvo vipanyuvaḥ panasyuvaḥ saṃvasaneṣvakramuḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-86-17).

The use of the word here shows its exact meaning. The two words *vipanyuvaḥ* and *panasyuvaḥ* are used together, and both are formed from the root *pan*. *Panasyuvaḥ* is explained as those who desire praise, and *vipanyuvaḥ* as praisers. In the present Ṛk, although *panitāraḥ* means praisers, one must note the special point here. This is not a scene of man praising and worshipping the gods; it is a scene of Indra and the others applauding man's praise. Hence *panitāraḥ* here means those who applaud, those who commend. This is the purport.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ः सु पू॒षा वृष॑णा सु॒हस्ता॑ दि॒वो न प्री॒ताः
श॑श॒यं दु॑दुह्रे ।
विश्वे॒ यद॑स्यां र॒णय॑न्त दे॒वाः प्र वोऽत्र॑ वसवः सु॒
म्नम॑श्याम् ॥ २ ॥

> *indraḥ su pūṣā vṛṣaṇā suhastā divo na prītāḥ śaśayaṃ duduhre |*
> *viśve yadasyāṃ raṇayanta devāḥ pra vo 'tra vasavaḥ sumnamaśyām ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रः । सु । पूषा । वृषणा । सुहस्ता । दिवः । न । प्रीताः । शशयं । दुदुह्रे ।
> विश्वे । यत् । अस्यां । रणयंत । देवाः । प्र । वः । अत्र । वसवः । सुम्नं अश्यां॥२॥

> *iṃdraḥ | su | pūṣā | vṛṣaṇā | suhastā | divaḥ | na | prītāḥ | śaśayaṃ | duduhre |*
> *viśve | yat | asyāṃ | raṇayaṃta | devāḥ | pra | vaḥ | atra | vasavaḥ | sumnaṃ aśyāṃ‖2‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वसवः सर्वस्य वासयितारो हे देवा इंद्रः पूषा च वृषणाभिमतफलस्य सेक्तारौ सुहस्ता कल्याणपाणी नासत्यौ मित्रावरुणौ वा । राजाना मित्रावरुणा सुपाणी इत्यादिषु दृष्टत्वात् । एते सर्वे देवाः । नेति संप्रत्यर्थे । इदानीं प्रीताः संतः शशयं नभसि शयानं मेघं दिवो नभसः सकाशात्सु दुदुहे । वृष्टिद्वारापेक्षितं फलं सुष्टु दुहंति । यद्यस्माद्विश्वे सर्वे देवा अस्यां वेद्यां

> रणयंत रमयंते वो युष्माकं संबंधिन्यत्रलोके सुम्मं सुखकरमपेक्षितं
> फलं प्राश्यां । प्राप्णुयां ॥ सुहस्ता । हसेरसिहसीत्यादिना तन्नृत्ययः । नित्तादा–
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> *vasavaḥ sarvasya vāsayitāro he devā iṃdraḥ pūṣā ca*
> *vṛṣaṇābhimataphalasya*
> *sektārau suhastā kalyāṇapāṇī nāsatyau mitrāvaruṇau vā | rājānā*
> *mitrāvaruṇā*
> *supāṇī ityādiṣu dṛṣṭatvāt | ete sarve devāḥ | neti saṃpratyarthe | idānīṃ*
> *prītāḥ saṃtaḥ śaśayaṃ nabhasi śayānaṃ meghaṃ divo nabhasaḥ*
> *sakāśātsu duduhe | vṛṣṭidvārāpekṣitaṃ phalaṃ suṣṭu duhaṃti |*
> *yadyasmādviśve sarve devā asyāṃ vedyāṃ*
> *raṇayaṃta ramayaṃte vo yuṣmākaṃ saṃbaṃdhinyatraloke summaṃ*
> *sukhakaramapekṣitaṃ*
> *phalaṃ prāśyāṃ | prāpṇuyāṃ ‖ suhastā | haserasihasītyādinā*
> *tannṛtyayaḥ | nittādā-*
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> द्युदात्तः । बहुव्रीहावाद्युदात्तं द्व्यच्छंदसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । दुदुहे ।
> दुह प्रपूरण इत्यस्य लिटीरयो रे । रणयंत । रमु क्रीडायां । ण्यंतस्य लजं
> रूपं । वर्णव्यापत्तिः । अश्यां । अशू व्याप्ताविर्यस्य लिजि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य
> लुक् । व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं ॥

> *dyudāttaḥ | bahuvrīhāvādyudāttaṃ*
> *dvyacchaṃdasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | duduhe |*
> *duha prapūraṇa ityasya liṭīrayo re | raṇayaṃta | ramu krīḍāyāṃ |*
> *ṇyaṃtasya lajaṃ*
> *rūpaṃ | varṇavyāpattiḥ | aśyāṃ | aśū vyāptāvityasya liji bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya*
> *luk | vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Vasus, causers of dwelling for all, O gods! Indra and Pūṣan are *vṛṣaṇā*, showerers of the desired fruit, and *suhastā*, fair-handed: either the Nāsatyas or Mitra and Varuṇa, since the epithet is seen in passages such as राजाना मित्रावरुणा सुपाणी (*rājānā mitrāvaruṇā supāṇī*). All these are the gods. *Na* is in the sense of "now". Being pleased now, they have well milked the cloud lying in the sky, *śaśayam*, from

heaven, from the sky; that is, they well draw out the fruit needed by way of rain. Since all the gods delight on this altar, may I here, in this world belonging to you, fully obtain the desired fruit that brings happiness." He then begins the grammar: the formation of *suhastā*, with its affix and its accent.[?172]

This part is only grammatical: the accent of *suhastā* (initial acute of the compound by the rule on compounds), the form *dudūhe* from the root *duh*, *raṇayanta* from the root *ramu* in the sense of play with the causative, and *aśyām* from the root *aśū* in the sense of pervading, with elision of the stem-vowel and a change of voice.

Word-to-word meaning

- वसवः (*vasavaḥ*)—O Vasus, givers of dwelling
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- पूषा (*pūṣā*)—the god Pūṣan
- वृषणा (*vṛṣaṇā*)—givers of what is desired
- सुहस्ता (*suhastā*)—Mitra and Varuṇa, possessed of excellent hands (or the Aśvin deities also)
- न (*na*)—now
- प्रीताः (*prītāḥ*)—being satisfied
- शशयं (*śaśayaṃ*)—the cloud abiding in the sky
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from the sky
- सु दुदुहे (*su duduhe*)—have milked, for the sake of rain
- यत् (*yat*)—for that very reason
- विश्वे देवाः (*viśve devāḥ*)—all the gods also
- अस्यां (*asyāṃ*)—on this sacrificial altar
- रणयंत (*raṇayaṃta*)—are delighting
- वः (*vaḥ*)—belonging to you
- अत्र (*atra*)—in this place
- सुम्नं (*summaṃ*)—the fruit that brings happiness
- प्र अश्यां (*pra aśyāṃ*)—may I obtain fully

Gist

Indra, the givers of dwelling, the god Pūṣan, and Mitra and Varuṇa, givers of what is desired and possessed of excellent hands, being satisfied now, have milked the cloud abiding in the sky from the sky for the sake of rain. For that very reason all the gods too are delighting on this sacrificial altar. May I obtain the fruit that brings happiness in this sacrificial place that belongs to you.

English translation

Indra and Pushan, the showerers (of benefits), and the happy-handed Ashwins, well affected towards us, have milked the (cloud) reposing in heaven ; wherefore, Vasus, universal deities, sporting on this (altar), may I here obtain the happiness derived from you.

Special Topics

This mantra is recited addressed to the deities who accomplish the sacrifice and, by causing rain, support it. At the beginning stands the praise of deities such as the Vasus, Indra and Pūṣan. The deities named Vasu are addressed with वसवः— सर्वस्य वासयितारः हे देवाः (*vasavaḥ — sarvasya vāsayitāraḥ he devāḥ*). Commonly this word may be an epithet of other deities too. All the deities who bestow grace on man's dwelling may be denoted by the word *vasu*. But from Sāyaṇa's explanation it is understood that in the present Ṛk a separate group of deities with the name Vasu is indicated

. Who are these Vasus? What is their nature? Why do they have this name? For these questions one must look at Yājñavalkya's answer.

अथ हैनं विदग्धः शाकल्यः पप्रच्छ । कति देवा याज्ञवल्केति । ....त्रयस्त्रिंशत्त्वेव देवा इति । कतमे ते त्रयस्त्रिंशदिति । अष्टौ वसवः, एकादशरुद्राः, द्वादशादित्याः, ते एकत्रिंशत् । इंद्रश्चैव प्रजापतिश्च. (*atha hainaṃ vidagdhaḥ śākalyaḥ papraccha | kati devā yājñavalketi | ....trayastriṃśattveva devā iti | katame te trayastriṃśaditi | aṣṭau vasavaḥ, ekādaśarudrāḥ, dvādaśādityāḥ, te ekatriṃśat | iṃdraścaiva prajāpatiśca.*) (Bṛ. U. 3-9-1-2).

Vidagdha, son of Śakala, asked Yājñavalkya: "How many gods are there?" When Yājñavalkya said "thirty-three", he asked again, "Who are they?" In reply Yājñavalkya explained the number of the gods:

"Eight Vasus, eleven Rudras, twelve Ādityas: these make thirty-one gods. Together with Indra and Prajāpati they become thirty-three." As to who these Vasus are:

अग्निश्च पृथिवी च वायुश्चांतरिक्षं चादित्यश्च द्यौश्च चंद्रमाश्च नक्षत्राणि चैते वसवः । एतेषु हीदं सर्वं हितमिति तस्माद्वसव इति ॥ (*agniśca pṛthivī ca vāyuścāṃtarikṣaṃ cādityaśca dyauśca caṃdramāśca nakṣatrāṇi caite vasavaḥ | eteṣu hīdaṃ sarvaṃ hitamiti tasmādvasava iti ‖*) (Bṛ. U. 3-9-3).

Agni, the earth, the wind, the atmosphere, the sun, the sky, the moon, the stars: these are the Vasus. Because all beings are placed in them, they are famed by the name Vasus. The explanation of Śaṅkara's commentary is: प्राणिनां कर्मफलाश्रयत्वेन कार्यकारणसंघातरूपेण तन्नि वासत्वेन च विपरिणमंतः जगदिदं सर्वं वासयंति च (*prāṇinām karmaphalāśrayatvena kāryakāraṇasaṃghātarūpeṇa tanni vāsatvena ca vipariṇamaṃtaḥ jagadidaṃ sarvaṃ vāsayaṃti ca*). According to the fruit of the actions of living beings they bring about changes in their bodies and limbs, enter into them themselves, provide the conveniences for all of them to dwell, and themselves dwell in all of them; hence the name Vasus.

स मनसा वाचं मिथुनगं्‌ समभवत्‌ । सोऽष्टौ द्रप्सान्गर्भ्यभवत्तेऽष्टौ वसवोऽसृज्यंत तानस्यामुपादधात्‌ । (*sa manasā vācaṃ mithunagṃ samabhavat | so 'ṣṭau drapsāngarbhyabhavatte 'ṣṭau vasavo 'sṛjyaṃta tānasyāmupādadhāt |*) (Śa. Brā. 6-1-2-6).

Prajāpati united with Speech by mental meditation. Then eight *drapsas* issued forth. They became the eight Vasus. He placed them on the earth. For that reason they are the deities residing on the earth; the Rudras were established in the atmosphere, and the Ādityas in the heavenly world. Since the Vasus are described as the presiding deities of the earth, what is the meaning of the many places where the Vasus are described as dwelling in the atmosphere, as in हगं्‌सश्युचिषद्वसुरंतरिक्षसत्‌ (*hagṃsaśyuciṣadvasuraṃtarikṣasat*)? This will be examined further on.

By the mantra अग्निश्च पृथिवी च (*agniśca pṛthivī ca*) it is stated that Agni is one of the Vasus. In some other places the Vasus are said to receive an oblation together with Agni at the morning pressing. So there is room for the questions whether Agni and the Vasus are identical or different deities, and likewise whether Indra and the Vasus are identical or different deities. Even though they are described together with different deities, it becomes clear that the luminous nature of the Vasus is described in the same way everywhere. In the statement that the Vasus, Rudras and Ādityas are the deities of the earth, the atmosphere and the heavenly world there are many hidden meanings. For the present, leaving that explanation aside, we may look in a general way at what the Vasus are in the present context.

Prayers such as इंद्रं नो अग्ने वसुभिः सजोषाः (*iṃdraṃ no agne vasubhiḥ sajoṣāḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-10-4) show the relation between the Vasus and Agni. The Chāndogya Upaniṣad describes this same thing: तद्यत्पथमममृतं तद्वसव उपजीवंत्यग्निना मुखेन न वै देवा अश्नंति न पिबंत्येतदेवामृतं दृष्ट्वा तृप्यंति । त एतदेव रूपमभिसंविशंत्येतस्माद्रूपादुद्यंति । स य एतदेवममृतं वेद वसूनामेवैको भूत्वाग्निनैव मुखेनैतदेवामृतं दृष्ट्वा तृप्यंति स एतदेव रूपमभि संवि शत्येतस्माद्रूपादुदेति । स यावदादित्यः पुरस्तादुदेता पश्चादस्तमेता वसूनामेव तावदाधिपत्यं स्वाराज्यं पर्येता ॥ (*tadyatpathamamamṛtaṃ tadvasava upajīvaṃtyagninā mukhena na vai devā aśnaṃti na pibaṃtyetadevāmṛtaṃ dṛṣṭvā tṛpyaṃti | ta etadeva rūpamabhisaṃviśaṃtyetasmādrūpādudyaṃti | sa ya etadevamamṛtaṃ veda vasūnāmevaiko bhūtvāgninaiva mukhenaitadevāmṛtaṃ dṛṣṭvā tṛpyaṃti sa etadeva rūpamabhi saṃvi śatyetasmādrūpādudeti | sa yāvadādityaḥ purastādudetā paścādastametā vasūnāmeva tāvadādhipatyaṃ svārājyaṃ paryetā* ‖) (Bhā U. 3-6)[?173]

The Vasus, with Agni as their mouth, drink the first nectar, which is of the form of the Ṛg-veda. That is: the gods neither eat nor drink; the meaning is that they are satisfied merely by seeing the nectar with the eye. The Vasus, satisfied by this same nectar, enter the red form of the Āditya (the sun) and issue forth from there. The meaning is that the nectar itself, transformed into the form of the Vasus, enters the Āditya. One who knows this principle also enters this same form of the Āditya and issues forth from there as radiance. For as long as the Āditya rises in the east and sets in the west, for so long this knower of the principle enjoys the lordship, the sovereignty and the self-rule of the Vasus; thus the greatness of the Vasus is described.

From the statement that they issue forth again from the Āditya, it is said that the Āditya's rays spreading toward the earth and the Vasus are identical. These rays of the Āditya are the cause of the influence of the seasons, and they are the cause of food and the like suited to each season; so the Vasus who exist in the form of these rays are the cause of this food. For this very reason they are praised for the sake of food.

तां वो देवाः सुमतिमूर्जयंतीमिषमश्याम वसवः शसा गोः । सा न सुदानुर्मृळयंती देवी प्रति द्रवंती सुविताय गम्याः ॥ (*tāṃ vo devāḥ sumatimūrjayaṃtīmiṣamaśyāma vasavaḥ śasā goḥ | sā na sudānurmṛḷayaṃtī devī prati dravaṃtī suvitāya gamyāḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-4) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-41-18)[?174]

"O divine Vasus, grant us to obtain, with the help of the sun's rays, the food that is a means for meditating with a pure mind and that increases strength. May that food produce every kind of happiness for us": the above view is indicated in this prayer. Moreover, when the course of the Āditya in the atmosphere is described, the point is made that the nature of the Vasus also helps the Āditya's revolution. For example—

यमेन दत्तं त्रित एनमायुनगिंद्र एणं प्रथमो अध्यतिष्ठत् । गंधर्वो अस्य रशनामगृभ्यात्सूरादश्वं वसवो निरतष्ट ॥ (*yamena dattaṃ trita enamāyunagiṃdra eṇaṃ prathamo adhyatiṣṭhat | gaṃdharvo asya raśanāmagṛbhyātsūrādaśvaṃ vasavo niratașṭa* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-163-2)[?175]

"This horse given by Yama was yoked to the chariot by Vāyu, who moves in the three places beginning with the earth. Indra, the foremost, mounted this horse. King Soma took the reins of this horse. The Vasus (the sun's rays) obtained this horse from the Āditya." Here Sāyaṇa has shown two kinds of meaning for वसवः (*vasavaḥ*): first the sun's rays, and second, as वसुशब्देनोक्ता (*vasuśabdenoktā*) ... यमादयः (*yamādayaḥ*) (Yama and the others, spoken of by the word "Vasu")[?176]. It is understood that these Vasus are not only occupants of the earth-place, as said above, but occupants of the places of the three worlds. The etymology of the Nirukta-kāra also supports this.

वसवो यद्विवसते सर्वमग्निर्वसुभिर्वासन इति समाख्या तस्मात्पृथिवीस्थानाः । इंद्रो वसुभिर्वासन इति समाख्या तस्मान्मध्यस्थासाः । वसव आदित्यरश्मयो विवासनात्तस्याद्दुस्थानाः ॥ (*vasavo yadvivasate sarvamagnirvasubhirvāsana iti samākhyā tasmātpṛthivīsthānāḥ | iṃdro vasubhirvāsana iti samākhyā tasmānmadhyasthāsāḥ | vasava ādityaraśmayo vivāsanāttasyāddusthānāḥ ‖*) (Ni. 12-41)

Agni pervades everything, covering it like a garment; therefore he is called Vāsana. This indicates the earth-place. Because Indra also has this property of pervasion, he too is called Vāsana; hence he is a deity of the middle place, the atmosphere. The radiant rays of the Āditya are likewise all-pervading, so they too are called Vasus; hence they may be deities of the heavenly place. After explaining thus, he cites the Taittirīya Saṃhitā sentence विश्वस्मै धत्त वसवो वसूनि (*viśvasmai dhatta vasavo vasūni*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-4-44-2) and shows the extended meaning of the word "vasu". In the Ṛk 1-163-2 cited above, the Vasus help the Āditya, who is in the heavenly world;

and since the Ṛk-saṃhitā itself also describes them as helping the atmospheric Maruts and the terrestrial Agni, it is understood that they pervade all three worlds.

ज्मया अत्र वसवो रंत देवा उरावंतरिक्षे मर्जयंत शुभ्राः । आर्वाक्पथ उरुज्रयः कृणुध्वं श्रोता दूतस्य जग्मुषो नो अस्य ॥ (*jmayā atra vasavo raṃta devā urāvaṃtarikṣe marjayaṃta śubhrāḥ | ārvākpatha urujrayaḥ kṛṇudhvaṃ śrotā dūtasya jagmuṣo no asya ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-39-3)

"May the deities called Vasus delight here in this sacrifice together with the terrestrial Agni, and may they also serve the Maruts who are in the wide atmosphere. O Maruts of abundant motion, and O Vasus their friends, join together, come facing us and follow us": so they are praised. Therefore it cannot be said that they are merely terrestrial deities. As the radiance of the Āditya in the heavenly world, they increase their power with the atmospheric Maruts, and then cause the form of the terrestrial Agni to shine more.

त्वे असुर्यं १ वसवो न्यृण्वन्कतुं हि ते मित्रमहो जुषंत । त्वं दस्योरोकसो अग्न आज उरु ज्योतिर्जनयन्नाराय ॥ (*tve asuryaṃ 1 vasavo nyṛṇvankatuṃ hi te mitramaho juṣaṃta | tvaṃ dasyorokaso agna āja uru jyotirjanayannārāya ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-5-6)

"O Agni, worthy of worship by all friends, the deities called Vasus have increased radiance in you and made your strength greater. They have also served the rite dear to you. With the brilliance increased by their help, be a benefactor of the sacrificers and destroy the enemies."

क्रतुं ह्यस्य वसवो जुषंताथा देवा दधिरे हव्यवाहं (*kratuṃ hyasya vasavo juṣaṃtāthā devā dadhire havyavāhaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-11.-)[?177]

"The deities accepted and honoured as Havyavāha the Agni, lord of the whole sacrifice, whom the Vasus serve, so helped": thus companionship with Agni is described. It is also made known that their influence is the cause of Agni's strength.

In the Upaniṣad sentence cited above, they are called the eight Vasus and their number is stated. In the Śabdakalpadruma their names are given as Dhara, Dhruva, Soma, Viṣṇu, Anila, Anala and Prabhāsa. Pointing to the same, the Viṣṇu Purāṇa gives eight names: Āpa, Dhruva, Soma, Dhava, Anila, Anala or Pāvaka, Pratyūṣa (Uṣas) and Prabhāsa. It is also said that all of these are various forms of the world-pervading radiance.

Just as, because it pervades the physical worlds, the particular influence of the Āditya and the rest bears the name "Vasu", so too, when a spiritual principle is taught, the principle of life-breath (prāṇa), which pervades the whole body, bears the name "Vasu".

पुरुषो वाव यज्ञस्तस्य यानि चतुर्विंशति वर्षाणि तत्पातःसवनं । चतुर्विंशत्यक्षरा गायत्री गायत्रं प्रातःसवनं तदस्य वसवोऽन्वायत्ताः प्राणा वाव वसवः एते हीदगं् सर्वं वासयंति ॥ (*puruṣo vāva yajñastasya yāni caturviṃśati varṣāṇi tatpātaḥsavanaṃ | caturviṃśatyakṣarā gāyatrī gāyatraṃ prātaḥsavanaṃ tadasya vasavo 'nvāyattāḥ prāṇā vāva vasavaḥ ete hīdagṃ sarvaṃ vāsayaṃti ||*) (Chā. U. 3-16-1)

The Puruṣa himself is of the form of the sacrifice. His first twenty-four years are the morning pressing. By a mantra in the Gāyatrī metre the oblation of the morning pressing is offered. Because it pervades all the limbs, lodged within his body so that the Puruṣa can dwell, prāṇa is well known by the name "Vasu". Therefore the particular principles that pervade the three worlds, beginning with the earth, of the infinite physical universe, both within the body of the Puruṣa and beyond the body, are those that bear the name "Vasu".

सुहस्ता (*suhastā*)—कल्याणपाणी नासत्यौ मित्रावरुणौ वा (*kalyāṇapāṇī nāsatyau mitrāvaruṇau vā*). Sāyaṇa has given two meanings: the Aśvins, having auspicious-acting hands, or else Mitra and Varuṇa. Having attractive hands is an ornament of Mitra and Varuṇa just as it is of the Aśvins.

अथ बाहू उद्गृष्णाति । हिरण्यरूपा उषसो विरोक उभाविंद्रो उदिथः सूर्यश्च । आरोहतं वरुण मित्र गर्तं ततश्चक्षाथामदितिं दितिं चेति बाहू वै मित्रावरुणौ ॥ (*atha bāhū udgṛṣṇāti | hiraṇyarūpā uṣaso viroka ubhāviṃdro udithaḥ sūryaśca | ārohataṃ varuṇa mitra gartaṃ tataścakṣāthāmaditiṃ ditiṃ ceti bāhū vai mitrāvaruṇau ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 5-4-1-15)

At the time of the consecration the king raises both arms, recites the mantra हिरण्य रूपा (*hiraṇya rūpā*) and prays to Mitra and Varuṇa: "O Mitra and Varuṇa, of form attractive like gold, mount as the Āditya mounts his chariot; and look upon Diti and Aditi." It is described that in praying so, those very arms are in the form of Mitra and Varuṇa. It can also be understood that in many contexts excellent hands reflect Mitra and Varuṇa. Moreover, mantras such as अश्विनोर्भाहुब्यां पूष्टो हस्ताभ्यां (*aśvinorbhāhubyāṃ pūṣṭo hastābhyāṃ*) praise the distinction of the arms of the Aśvins. Since this epithet can thus fit both, either meaning may be given here.

शशयं (*śaśayaṃ*)—Formed from the root शी (*śī*), this word is used to describe a thing that lies asleep. The meaning is that they called the sleeping cloud for the sake of rain.

रणयंत (*raṇayaṃta*)—रमयंति, शब्दयंत्येव (*ramayaṃti, śabdayaṃtyeva*). The word is used in the senses "rejoice" and "make sound". On the basis of the original meaning "delightful", the word raṇa is also a synonym of battle. Words such as रराणता (*rarāṇatā*) and रणंत (*raṇaṃta*) are used both in describing a sound expressing joy, "victory is assured", while fighting, and when Sāmans such as the Rathantara are chanted at the time of the sacrifice.

सुम्मं (*summaṃ*)—The word summa is read among the words for happiness (Ni. 3-6). In some places of the Ṛk-saṃhitā it is also used in the sense of favour. But use in the sense of happiness is the more frequent.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

या जा॒मयो॒ वृष्णं॑ इ॒च्छन्तिं॑ श॒क्तिं नं॑म॒स्यन्ती॑र्जानते॒ गर्भ॑मस्मिन् ।
अच्छां॑ पु॒त्रं धे॒नवों॑ वावशा॒ना म॒हश्चं॑रन्ति॒ बिभ्रं॑तं॒ वपूं॑षि ॥ ३ ॥

> *yā jāmayo vṛṣṇa icchanti śaktiṃ namasyantīrjānate garbhamasmin |*
> *acchā putraṃ dhenavo vāvaśānā mahaścaranti bibhrataṃ vapūṃṣi ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> याः । जामयः । वृष्णे । इच्छंति । शक्तिं । नमस्यंतीः । जानते । गर्भं । अस्मिन् ।
> अच्छ । पुत्रं । धेनवः । वावशानाः । महः । चरंति । बिभ्रतं । वपूंषि ॥ ३ ॥

> *yāḥ | jāmayaḥ | vṛṣṇe | icchaṃti | śaktiṃ | namasyaṃtīḥ | jānate | garbhaṃ | asmin |*
> *accha | putraṃ | dhenavaḥ | vāvaśānāḥ | mahaḥ | caraṃti | bibhrataṃ | vapūṃṣi ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> या जामयः । जमंति वर्षाकाले प्रादुर्भवंतीति जामय ओषधयः ।
> वृष्णेऽपां वर्षकायेंद्राय शक्तिं सेचनसावर्थमिच्छंति । नमस्यंतीः प्रह्वेभूतास्ता ओषधयोऽस्मिन्निंद्रे गर्भं वृष्टिद्वारा पुष्पफलादिलक्षणगर्भादानादिसामर्थ्यं जानते । जानंति ।
> वावशानाः फलं कामयमाना धेनवः सर्वस्य प्रीणयित्र्य ओषधयो महो महांति नानाप्रकाराणि वपूंषि रूपाणि बिभ्रतं व्रीहियवनीवारादिफललक्षणं पुत्रं तनयमच्छाभिमुखेन चरंति ।
> प्राप्नुवंति । लोके

> *yā jāmayaḥ | jamaṃti varṣākāle prādurbhavaṃtīti jāmaya oṣadhayaḥ | vṛṣṇe 'pāṃ varṣakāyeṃdrāya śaktiṃ secanasāvarthamicchaṃti | namasyaṃtīḥ prahnebhūtāstā oṣadhayo 'sminniṃdre garbhaṃ vṛṣṭidvārā puṣpaphalādilakṣaṇagarbhādānādisāmarthyaṃ jānate | jānaṃti | vāvaśānāḥ phalaṃ kāmayamānā dhenavaḥ sarvasya prīṇayitrya oṣadhayo maho mahāṃti nānāprakārāṇi vapūṃṣi rūpāṇi bibhrataṃ vrīhiyavanīvārādiphalalakṣaṇaṃ putraṃ tanayamacchābhimukhena caraṃti | prāpnuvaṃti | loke*

> हि हंभारवं कुर्वाणा धेनवो वत्समभिलक्ष्य गच्छंति । तद्वत् । यद्वा । जामयः । जमंति सर्वत्र प्रसरंतीति जामयः सूर्यदीप्तयः । वृष्णेऽपां वर्षकाय । स्वरश्मिभिर्भौमान्रसानादाय पुनर्वर्षतीति वर्षकः सूर्यः । आदित्याज्जायते वृष्टिरिति स्मृतेश्च । तस्मै वर्षणशक्तिमिच्छंति । ता दीप्तयोऽस्मिन्नादित्ये गर्भमब्रूपगर्भाधानसःमर्थ्यं जानंति ॥ जामयः । जमतेर्गतिकर्मणो जनिघसिभ्यामिण्णिति विधीयमानो बहुलवचनादस्मादपि भवति । नमस्यंतीः । नवः8रब्दान्नमोवरिवश्चित्रजः क्यजिति क्यच् । तदंताच्छतरि रूपं । प्रत्ययस्वरः । जानते । ज्ञा अवबोधन इत्यस्य लट रूपं । अच्च । निपातस्य चेति संहितायां दीर्घः ॥

> *hi haṃbhāravaṃ kurvāṇā dhenavo vatsamabhilakṣya gacchaṃti | tadvat | yadvā | jāmayaḥ | jamaṃti sarvatra prasaraṃtīti jāmayaḥ sūryadīptayaḥ | vṛṣṇe 'pāṃ varṣakāya | svaraśmibhirbhaumānrasānādāya punarvarṣatīti varṣakaḥ sūryaḥ | ādityājjāyate vṛṣṭiriti smṛteśva | tasmai varṣaṇaśaktimicchaṃti | tā dīptayo 'sminnāditye garbhamabrūpagarbhādhānasaḥmarthyaṃ jānaṃti ‖ jāmayaḥ | jamatergatikarmaṇo janighasibhyāmiṇṇiti vidhīyamāno bahulavacanādasmādapi bhavati | namasyaṃtīḥ | navaḥ8rabdānnamovarivaścitrajaḥ kyajiti kyac | tadaṃtācchatari rūpaṃ | pratyayasvaraḥ | jānate | jñā avabodhana ityasya laṭa rūpaṃ | acca | nipātasya ceti saṃhitāyāṃ dīrghaḥ ‖*

Summary

या जामयः (*yā jāmayaḥ*): the jāmayaḥ are the plants, because they spring up (जमंति (*jamaṃti*)) in the rainy season. They desire power (śakti), the capacity of pouring out, for the showerer (वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*)), Indra, who sends down the waters. नमस्यंतीः (*namasyaṃtīḥ*): those plants, bowed down, know in this Indra the capacity of impregnation through rain, the embryo in the form of flowers, fruits and the like (जानते (*jānate*) = they know). वावशानाः (*vāvaśānāḥ*): desiring fruit; धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*): the plants, which gratify everyone; महः (*mahaḥ*): great, of many kinds; वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*): forms. They go facing, that is, reach, the son (पुत्रं (*putraṃ*)) who bears (बिभ्रतं (*bibhrataṃ*)) these forms, namely the fruit in the form of rice, barley, wild rice and the like. (The sentence continues on the next page.)

As in the world cows, lowing, go toward the calf, so here. Or else: जामयः (*jāmayaḥ*) are the sun's rays, since they spread (जमंति (*jamaṃti*)) everywhere. वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*): for the rain-maker; the sun is the rain-maker, because with his rays he takes up the earthly juices and rains again; and the smṛti says "from the Āditya rain is born". They desire the power of raining for him. Those rays know in this Āditya the capacity of impregnation, the embryo in the form of water.

Word-to-word meaning

- या जामय (*yā jāmaya*)—the plants
- वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*)—to Indra, the maker of rain
- शक्तिं (*śaktiṃ*)—the capacity of pouring out
- इच्छति (*icchati*)—wish for
- नमस्यंतीः (*namasyaṃtīḥ*)—the plants that have attained humility
- अस्मिन् (*asmin*)—in this Indra
- गर्भं (*garbhaṃ*)—the capacity to produce the embryo in the form of flowers and the like
- जानते (*jānate*)—have known
- वावशानाः (*vāvaśānāḥ*)—those that desire fruits
- धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*)—the plants, gratifiers of the world
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—of many kinds
- वपूंषि (*vapūṃṣi*)—forms such as grain
- बिभ्रतं (*bibhrataṃ*)—possessing
- पुत्रं (*putraṃ*)—the fruits in the form of sons
- चरंति (*caraṃti*)—obtain

Gist

All the plants desire from Indra, the maker of creation[?178], the capacity of pouring out. These plants, having attained humility, have known that Indra has the capacity of producing the embryo in the form of flowers and the like. The plants, which desire fruits and gratify the world, obtain the fruits in the form of sons, which possess many kinds of forms such as grain.

English translation

The plants that desire for the showerer (Indra) the power (of sending rain) appreciate, when manifest, the embryo (blossom) deposited in him : the cows desirous of reward come to the presence of the calf, invested with many forms

Special Topics

For this Ṛk Sāyaṇa has shown that two kinds of meaning are possible. For जामयः (*jāmayaḥ*) he first gives the meaning plants and trees. If this meaning is right, वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*) is a word equivalent to Indra. धेनवः (*dhenavaḥ*) too must be an epithet of the plants. Or else जामयः (*jāmayaḥ*)

If jāmayaḥ is taken to mean the sun's rays, then vṛṣṇe must be a synonym of Āditya (the sun), and dhenavaḥ too must be an epithet of the sun's rays. Both kinds of purport are appropriate, yet there is more room for the second, the one concerning Āditya. First:

jāmayaḥ—जमंति वर्षाकाले प्रादुर्भवंतीति जामयः ओषधयः । (*jamaṃti varṣākāle prādurbhavaṃtīti jāmayaḥ oṣadhayaḥ* |) Because plants spring up in the rainy season, they are called jāmis. The word is formed from the root jam in the sense of motion. The Nirukta-writers have given two explanations of it: जामिरन्ने 5- स्यां जनयंति जामपत्यं । जमतीर्वा स्याद्गतिकर्मणो निर्गमनप्राया भवति (*jāmiranne 5- syāṃ janayaṃti jāmapatyaṃ* | *jamatīrvā syāddatikarmaṇo nirgamanaprāyā bhavati*) (Ni. 3-9) One derivation: it is formed from the root jan, "to be born", the thought being that another man causes children to be born in her; jāmi is then she who goes to her husband's house. The other: it is formed from the root jam, "to move", and gives the same sense. In the rainy season the sprouts move, that is, appear. Thus one derivation lets us state a purport in which jāmayaḥ is a synonym for plants. By the other derivation the word means kinsfolk. In many contexts it is used in this sense. But "kinsfolk" may be a sister, a wife, a mother, a friend, or any male belonging to a person's side. For example:

अंबयो यंत्यध्वभिर्जामयो अध्वरीयतां । पृंचतीर्मधुना पयः । (*aṃbayo yaṃtyadhvabhirjāmayo adhvarīyatāṃ | pṛṃcatīrmadhunā payaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-23-16)

The waters, like mothers, flow beneficially as mothers do.

आ घा ता गच्छानुत्तरा युगानि यत्र जामयः कृणवन्नजामि ॥ (*ā ghā tā gacchānuttarā yugāni yatra jāmayaḥ kṛṇavannajāmi ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-12-13)

The jāmi chooses one who is not a jāmi; that is, a sister chooses one who is not a brother.

ते मायिनो ममिरे सुप्रचेतनो जामी सयोनी मिथुना समोकसा ॥ (*te māyino mamire supracetano jāmī sayonī mithunā samokasā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-129-4)

Heaven and earth, being jāmis, held the ray under control; here heaven and earth mean "sisters". In the same sense jāmayaḥ means svasāraḥ, the fingers. To denote the mutual relation of the fingers, which serve the sacrifice and help one another, in "हिन्वंति स्वसारो जामयः (*hinvaṃti svasāro jāmayaḥ*)

पतिं (*patiṃ*)" (9-65-1) jāmayaḥ is used in the sense of "wives" of Soma.

"जहि शूर शत्रून् जामिमजामिं मघवन् अमित्रान् (*jahi śūra śatrūn jāmimajāmiṃ maghavan amitrān*)" (6-44-17): "Kill the enemy, whether kinsman or non-kinsman". In this mantra the word is used in a broad sense, without showing a definite kinship. Since the sense must be stated according to context, what relationship is meant here between Indra and the plants? Husband and wife? Father and daughter? Or helper and helped? The question is natural. All these relationships can be shown in this context. It is well known that the creation and growth of plants come through rain, and that rain is possible only by Indra's favour; so the relation of helper belongs to Indra. The essence of the plants is the rain-water, and the essence of the rain-water is the plant:

आपो ह ना ओषधिनाग्ं सारः .... ओषधय उ अपाग्ं्रसः । (*āpo ha nā oṣadhināgṃ sāraḥ .... oṣadhaya u apāgṃrasaḥ |*) (Śa. Brā. 3-6-1-7)

Since the inner essence of water and the sap of the plants are one, Indra, the cause of the standing of the rain-water, is also the cause of the nourishing of the plants' sap. And by killing Vṛtra, the common enemy of both, he became helper to the growth of both.

अथ दर्भस्तंभ मुपदधाति । एतद्वै देवा ओषधीरुपादधत तथैवैतद्यजमान ओषधीरुपधत्ते । जायत एष .... आपश्च हैता ओषधयश्च या वै वृत्राद्बीभत्समाना आपः ... . तेनौषधय उभयेन्नैवैनमेतदन्नेन प्रीणाति ॥ (*atha darbhastaṃbha mupadadhāti | etadvai devā oṣadhīrupādadhata tathaivaitadyajamāna oṣadhīrupadhatte | jāyata eṣa .... āpaśca haitā oṣadhayaśca yā vai vṛtrādbībhatsamānā āpaḥ ... . tenauṣadhaya ubhayennaivainametadannena prīṇāti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 7-2-3 to 1-3)

The sacrificer's setting up of the darbha is a reflection of the gods' setting up of the plants and the rest. This darbha is the representative of the food the sacrificer desires. The essence of both water and plants, the causes of the sap of food, is contained in this darbha. The water, frightened of Vṛtra, appeared on the dry earth as darbha and as bushes; hence the essence of water and of plants is contained in it. By slaying Vṛtra, enemy of both, Indra became their helper. Therefore the plants became jāmis to him, that is, kinsfolk: one purport can be stated thus.

युष्मा इंद्रोऽवृणीत वृत्रतूर्य इति (*yuṣmā iṃdro 'vṛṇīta vṛtratūrya iti*) (Śa. Brā. 1-1-3-8): Indra won victory with the help of the waters when fighting Vṛtra. All such descriptions show the jāmi-relationship between Indra, the waters, and the plants, their essence.

Since the power of pouring rain and the power of producing plants are contained in Indra, the epithet vṛṣṇe is fitting for him. "यश्चंदसामृषभो विश्वरूपः .... समेंद्रो मेधया स्पृणोतु (*yaścaṃdasāmṛṣabho viśvarūpaḥ .... sameṃdro medhayā spṛṇotu*)" (Tai. U. 1-4): this Indra, by his power of lordship, has the universe as his form, and is described as ṛṣabha (vṛṣabha) and so on. Since the whole universe comes about from Indra, who has such a supreme nature, he is as a womb to the plants and to their flowers and fruits. Thus the sense referring to Indra is natural.

If jāmayaḥ is taken as the sun's rays and vṛṣṇe as an epithet of the sun, how is it consistent? Sāyaṇa: यद्वा जामयः । जमंति सर्वत्र प्रसरंतीति जामयः सूरदीप्तयः । वृष्णेऽपां वर्षकाय । स्वरशिभिर्भौमान् रसानादाय पुनर्वर्षतीति वर्षकः सूरः (*yadvā jāmayaḥ | jamaṃti sarvatra prasaraṃtīti jāmayaḥ sūradīptayaḥ | vṛṣṇe 'pāṃ varṣakāya | svaraśibhirbhaumān rasānādāya punarvarṣatīti varṣakaḥ sūraḥ*). The word jāmi, from the root jam in the sense of motion, means "spreading everywhere"; here the sun's rays, spreading to all regions, are meant. Because the sun draws up water with his rays and again pours rain on the earth, he is marked by the epithet vṛṣṇe. Even if jāmi is taken as "kinsman", there is no room to ask what kinship holds between the sun and his rays; the relation of part and whole is what the word jāmi conveys here.

If jāmi is taken as the sun's rays, their nature of spreading through the universe is shown. Earlier, in explaining Ṛk 1-156-2, on the words "वर्षिष्ठमुप गाव आगुः (*varṣiṣṭhamupa gāva āguḥ*)", the form of the rays' spreading through the universe was described with examples from the Śruti. Here these same rays bear the epithet dhenavaḥ. What nature does it show? The word dhenu conveys satisfying and helping: धेनुर्धयतीर्वा, धिनोतीर्वा, धयतेऽसौ वत्सेनेति । तर्पयत्यसौ पयसा। (*dhenurdhayatīrvā, dhinotīrvā, dhayate 'sau vatseneti | tarpayatyasau payasā*|) (Ni. 11-42) The chief sense, "satisfies by giving milk", shows the chief mark of the dhenu. Not only the cow: in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā, in many contexts that bring satisfaction, there is a dhenu-metaphor, as the cow satisfies her calf with her milk. For example, in mantras such as उपह्वये सुदघां धेनु (*upahvaye sudaghāṃ dhenu*) there is a description of the cloud-cow that gives the world satisfaction through rain (1-164-26). The one who milks this cloud-cow is Āditya; hence he is vṛṣan. Wherever the sun's rays or the radiant Dawn are described, the quality of the dhenu is present. Though it is a matter of common experience that Dawn and the sun's rays give joy to the world,

in the eyes of the Ṛṣis, the authors of the Ṛk-Saṃhitā, the principle called dhenu holds a venerable place; hence such descriptions are very many. If only a few examples are examined, the fitness of this metaphor becomes clear.

अबोध्यग्निः समिधा जनानां प्रति धेनुमिवायतीमुषासं । यह्वा इव प्र वयामुज्जि हानाः प्र भानवः सिस्रते नाकमच्छ ॥ (*abodhyagniḥ samidhā janānāṃ prati dhenumivāyatīmuṣāsaṃ | yahvā iva pra vayāmujji hānāḥ pra bhānavaḥ sisrate nākamaccha ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-1-1)

Dawn, who gladdens the whole world, appears in the sky and comes like a cow rich in milk. The flames of Agni, like calves, or like birds flying up to settle on a branch, spread upward from Agni and run towards Dawn: a wonderful description.

एता धियं कृणवामा सखायोप या माता ऋणुत व्रजं गोः । (*etā dhiyaṃ kṛṇavāmā sakhāyopa yā mātā ṛṇuta vrajaṃ goḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-45-6)

In such places Dawn is shown as mother-like to the sun's rays.

आ धेनवो धुनयंतामशिश्वीः सबर्दुघाः शशया अप्रदुग्धाः । नव्यानव्या युवतयो भवंतीर्महद्देवानामसुरत्वमेकं ॥ (*ā dhenavo dhunayaṃtāmaśiśvīḥ sabardughāḥ śaśayā apradugdhāḥ | navyānavyā yuvatayo bhavaṃtīrmahaddevānāmasuratvamekaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-55-16)

The cow-clouds, dear to the world, though without calves, come towards the earth and pour the nectar of rain. Whether the cloud or the sun's rays are described, since they cause the rain that brings satisfaction, there is the dhenu-metaphor. Where these metaphors occur the particular purport is also noteworthy: the same idea is not repeated everywhere, and the constant variety of idea adorns the description of each setting.

त्रिरस्मै सप्त धेनवो दुदुहे सत्यामाशिरं पूर्व्यं व्योमनि । चत्वान्यार्ं भुवनानि निर्णिजे चारूणि चक्रे यदृतैरवर्धत ॥ (*trirasmai sapta dhenavo duduhe satyāmāśiraṃ pūrvya vyomani | catvārnyā bhuvanāni nirṇije cārūṇi cakre yadṛtairavardhata ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-70-1)

In such places the dhenu-metaphor gives a very profound meaning. Since such contexts are many, the charm of such metaphors is explained in each. Here dhenavaḥ, as a synonym of jāmayaḥ, indicates the principle of the sun's rays: that they bring joy to the world.

jānate garbham asmin—If the sense refers to Indra, the purport is that the womb contains the flowers and fruits of the plants. If it refers to Āditya, a wider purport must be stated. Since all the gods, Indra, Agni and the rest, are united in Āditya, or are particular manifestations of him, whatever powers of the womb each of these gods has individually are all contained in Āditya. When the lightning-fire or the sun is described, the sense of the word garbha is common. Or it would not be wrong to say that Agni, Sūrya, Viṣṇu, Āditya, garbha are words denoting identity. As "womb of the waters" is a synonym for Agni, so it is for Āditya; one may also say that the world is contained in their womb. A few examples may be examined of how, when Viṣṇu, Agni, and Āditya are praised, they are called by synonyms of garbha. In some places Agni is said to lie in the womb of all things; elsewhere the whole world is said to lie in Agni's womb. Of Agni:

बह्वे नां गर्भो अपसामुपस्थान्महान्नविर्निश्वरति स्वधावान् । (*bahve nāṃ garbho apasāmupasthānmahānnavirniśvarati svadhāvān |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-95-3)

गर्भो यो अपां गर्भो वनानां गर्भश्च स्थातां गर्भश्च रथां । (*garbho yo apāṃ garbho vanānāṃ garbhaśca sthātāṃ garbhaśca rathāṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-70-2)

These show that Agni lies in all things as a womb, and that his nature cannot be known by ordinary effort. Moreover, this Agni, like a son in the waters of the cloud in the form of lightning, afterwards receives the sacrificial offering and causes the rain-waters, his mothers, to be born. Hidden in the lightning-form among the cloud-waters, he comes out from the middle of the sea as the submarine fire. This same Agni is the womb of the waters, the womb of plants; or the waters and plants are his womb: so it is described. Of Viṣṇu:

तमु स्तोतारः पूर्व्यं यथा विद ऋतस्य गर्भं जनुषा पिपर्तन । (*tamu stotāraḥ pūrvyaṃ yathā vida ṛtasya garbhaṃ januṣā pipartana |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-156-3)

Viṣṇu is eternal, perfect, the womb of the sacrifice, born as the sacrifice; or the womb of the water. This epithet is given because water is the origin of creation and Viṣṇu in the form of Hiraṇyagarbha is its support. Of Āditya:

उत्तानयोश्च व्वो३र्योनिरंतरत्रा पिता दुहितुर्गर्भमाधत् । (*uttānayośca vvo3ryoniraṃtaratrā pitā duhiturgarbhamādhat* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-16 = 13[?] [179]

In the middle of these heaven and earth, which are stretched upward and serve for enjoyment like cups, in the atmosphere, the place of the maker of all beings, Āditya holds in his womb the water, the womb of his daughter, the earth.

दिव्यं सुपर्णं नायसं बृहंतमपां गर्भं दर्शतमोषधीनां । (*divyaṃ suparṇaṃ nāyasaṃ bṛhaṃtamapāṃ garbhaṃ darśatamoṣadhīnāṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-52)

Āditya dwells in heaven, has an excellent means of descent, is a mover, is the womb of the waters and of the plants. Thus these deities are denoted by words for garbha. Moreover, in many contexts it is explained that the names Agni, Viṣṇu, Āditya are words for different forms of one principle and do not denote different deities. The description of Agni as "अपां गर्भः (*apāṃ garbhaḥ*)", "आसुर गर्भः (*āsura garbhaḥ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-29-11) applies also to Āditya. As Āditya is called the womb of heaven and earth, so Agni is called "रोदस्योः गर्भं (*rodasyoḥ garbhaṃ*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-1-2). In Ṛk 1-164-52 cited above, that same Agni is designated "दिव्यं सुपर्णं (*divyaṃ suparṇaṃ*)", a description showing a solar nature. Therefore, if garbham in the present Ṛk is taken to refer to Āditya, the purport is that the jāmi-rays knew Āditya, who bore in his own womb the whole universe in the form of Hiraṇyagarbha, that is, they knew his pervasion of the universe. To show his pervasion, one may say that he lies in the womb of the universe, or that he has hidden the whole universe in his own womb. Sāyaṇa states the purport referring to Āditya thus: अब्रूपगर्भाधानसामर्थ्यं वहंति (*abrūpagarbhādhānasāmarthyaṃ vahaṃti*).

mahaḥ vapūṃṣi bibhratam—they know the womb-form that bears bodies of many forms. If jāmayaḥ is taken as plants, the forms are the many kinds: rice, barley, nīvāra and so on. If taken as the sun's rays: काळी कराळी च मनोजवा च सुलोहिता या च सुधूम्रवर्णा । स्पुलिंगिनी विश्वरुची च देवी लेलायमाना इति सप्तजिह्वाः (*kāḷī karāḷī ca manojavā ca sulohitā yā ca sudhūmravarṇā | spuliṃginī viśvarucī ca devī lelāyamānā iti* *saptajihvāḥ*) (Mu. U. 1-2-4[?180]). As the flames of fire in the form of the Supreme Brahman are described in such sentences, so the many forms of the sun's rays are to be understood.

अमी ये सप्त रश्मयस्तत्रा मे नाभिरातता । (*amī ye sapta raśmayastatrā me nābhirātatā* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-105-9)

The many forms of the sun's rays described in such Ṛks were explained earlier.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अच्छा॑ विवक्मि॒ रोद॑सी सु॒मेके॒ ग्राव्णो॑ युजा॒नो अ॑ध्व॒रे म॑नी॒षा ।
इ॒मा उ॑ ते॒ मन॑वे॒ भूरि॑वारा ऊ॒र्ध्वा भ॑वन्ति दर्श॒ता यज॑त्राः ॥ ४ ॥

> *acchā vivakmi rodasī sumeke grāvṇo yujāno adhvare manīṣā |*
> *imā u te manave bhūrivārā ūrdhvā bhavanti darśatā yajatrāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अच्छ । विवक्कि । रोदसी इति । सुमेके इति सुमेके । ग्राव्यः । युजानः । अध्वरे ।
> मनीषा ।
> इमाः। ऊं इति । ते । मनवे । भूरिवाराः । ऊर्ध्वाः । भवंति । दर्शताः ।
> यजत्राः ॥ ४ ॥

> *accha | vivakki | rodasī iti | sumeke iti sumeke | grāvyaḥ | yujānaḥ |*
> *adhvare |*
> *manīṣā |*
> *imāḥ| ūṃ iti | te | manave | bhūrivārāḥ | ūrdhvāḥ | bhavaṃti |*
> *darśatāḥ |*
> *yajatrāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अध्वरे यज्ञे ग्राज्ञः सोमाभिषवार्थमुपलान् युजानः प्रयुंजानेऽहं सुमेके सुरूपे रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यौ मनीषा मनस ईषया स्तुतिलक्षणया
> वाचाच्छ विवक्कि । अभिमुख्येन सौमि । हे अग्ने ते तव भूरिवारा यजमानैर्बहुवारं वरणीया दर्शताः कमनीयतया दर्शनीया यजत्रा: पूज्या इमा दीप्तयो
> मनवे मनुष्यव्यवहारार्थमूर्ध्वा ऊर्ध्वमुखा भवंति ॥ विवक्कि । वच परिभाषणे ।
> लटि बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः । अर्तिपिपर्त्योश्च बहुलं छंदसीत्यभ्यासस्येत्वं ।
> चकारस्य कुत्वं व्यत्ययेन । युजानः । युजिबुधिदृशः किच्चेत्यानच् । कित्तादगुणः।
> चित्तादंतोदात्तः । मनीषा । सुपो डादेशः ॥

> *adhvare yajñè grājñaḥ somābhiṣavārthamupalān yujānaḥ prayuṃjāne 'haṃ sumeke surūpe rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyau manīṣā manasa īṣayā stutilakṣaṇayā*
> *vācāccha vivakki | abhimukhyena saumi | he agne te tava bhūrivārā yajamānairbahuvāraṃ varaṇīyā darśatāḥ kamanīyatayā darśanīyā yajatrā: pūjyā imā dīptayo*
> *manave manuṣyavyavahārārthamūrdhvā ūrdhvamukhā bhavaṃti ‖ vivakki | vaca paribhāṣaṇe |*
> *laṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ | artipipartyośca bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyabhyāsasyètvaṃ |*
> *cakārasya kutvaṃ vyatyayena | yujānaḥ | yujibudhidṛśaḥ kiccetyānac | kittādaguṇaḥ|*
> *cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | manīṣā | supo ḍādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

I, who am employing the pressing-stones for the pressing of Soma at the sacrifice (अध्वरे (*adhvare*)), address (विवक्कि (*vivakki*)) the beautiful heaven and earth (सुमेके (*sumeke*) रोदसी (*rodasī*)), facing them, with speech in the form of praise. मनीषा (*manīṣā*) is explained as "by the impulse of the mind", that is, by speech of the nature of praise. Then, to Agni: these flames of yours, much chosen by the sacrificers (भूरिवारा (*bhūrivārā*)), lovely to see through their desirability (दर्शताः (*darśatāḥ*)), and worthy of worship (यजत्राः (*yajatrāḥ*)), turn upward (ऊर्ध्वा (*ūrdhvā*)) for the sake of Manu, that is, for the business of men.

Word-to-word meaning

- अध्वरे (*adhvare*)—in the sacrifice
- ग्राव्यः (*grāvyaḥ*)—the stones that press the Soma
- युजानः (*yujānaḥ*)—I, who hold them for the pressing
- सुमेके(*sumeke*)—of excellent form
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth
- मनीषा (*manīṣā*)—with speech in the form of praise
- अच्छ विवक्मि (*accha vivakki*)—standing facing them, I recite (O Agni)
- भूरिवाराः (*bhūrivārāḥ*)—much desired by the sacrificers
- दर्शताः (*darśatāḥ*)—of attractive form
- यजत्राः (*yajatrāḥ*)—worthy of worship
- ते इमाः (*te imāḥ*)—these rays of yours
- मनवे (*manave*)—for the business of men
- ऊर्ध्वाः (*ūrdhvāḥ*)—turned upward
- भवंति (*bhavaṃti*)—spread out

Gist

At the sacrifice I stand ready, holding the stones in order to crush and press out the Soma juice, and I recite to heaven and earth, which are of excellent juice, standing facing them, with speech in the form of praise. O Agni, these rays of yours, which are desired by the sacrificers, of attractive form and worthy of worship, spread upward for the business of men.

English translation

I glorify with praise the beautiful heaven and earth, taking in hand the stones (to express the libation) at the sacrifice, as these your graceful, adorable, and many-blessing rays (Agni) mount up for the good of man.

Special Topics

अध्वरे (*adhvare*)—ध्वरतिः हिंसाकर्म (*dhvaratiḥ hiṃsākarma*) (Ni. 1-8). The word is formed from the root ध्व (*dhva*), which gives the sense "to cause injury". अध्वरे (*adhvare*) means "in the sacrifice that is free from injury".

ग्रावः (*grāvaḥ*)—सोमाभिषवार्थमुपलान् (*somābhiṣavārthamupalān*). It means the stones held for crushing and pressing the Soma juice. Although the two words ग्राव (*grāva*) and अद्रि (*adri*) both have in common usage the general sense "stone", it can be said, from their descriptions and epithets, that the ग्राव (*grāva*) and the अद्रि (*adri*) that serve to press out the Soma juice must have differed in their very form. Generally, where the word ग्राव (*grāva*) is used the bhāṣya gives it the meaning "stone", and where the word अद्रि (*adri*) stands it gives the meaning ग्राव (*grāva*). But this difference of meaning is not the basis for showing how they differ. From the epithets and comparisons that describe their form, and from the words that denote the sound they make while the Soma is pressed, it is understood that these two implements are different. बृहाण (*bṛhāṇa*) (5-41-12); पर्वत (*parvata*) (10-94-1); अश्रमण (*aśramaṇa*), अश्वथित (*aśvathita*), अमृत्यु (*amṛtyu*), अनातुर (*anātura*), अजर (*ajara*), आमविष्णु (*āmaviṣṇu*) (10-94-11), क्षेमकाम (*kṣemakāma*) (10-94-12): all of these are epithets showing the distinctive character of the अद्रि (*adri*); epithets such as पृथु (*pṛthu*) and पृथुबुध (*pṛthubudha*) show the distinctive character of the ग्राव (*grāva*) alone. The ग्राव (*grāva*) is generally compared to a bull, and the अद्रि (*adri*) to a horse.

Some portions of the Grāva-stotra make known the greatness of this ग्राव (*grāva*). According to the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra, this praise comprises the sūkta 10-94, which praises the ग्राव (*grāva*) directly, preceded by the mantras Ṛ. Saṃ. 1, 24, 3; 5, 81, 1; 8, 41, 1; 8, 1, 1. At the end the sūkta 10-175 is recited.

Of these, the mantras 1, 24, 3; 5, 81, 1 and 10, 175 are addressed to the deity Savitṛ. Since he is the impeller of all, he is prayed to impel the pressing of the juice. For example:

प्र वो ग्रावाणः सविता देवः सुवतु धर्मणा । धूर्षु युज्यध्वं सुनुत ॥ (*pra vo grāvāṇaḥ savitā devaḥ suvatu dharmaṇā | dhūrṣu yujyadhvaṃ sunuta ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 18-175-1)?[181]

O pressing-stones, may the god Savitṛ, the impeller of all, impel you to the pressing of Soma. At the places of pressing, join together with faith and with eagerness for the work, and press. In the same way the stones are praised by mantras such as ग्रावाणः अप दुच्छुनामप सेधत दुर्मतिं (*grāvāṇaḥ apa duccunāmapa sedhata durmatiṃ*). Besides these, we may examine just a few of the mantras that are recited describing the beneficial and purifying sound the stones make at the time of pressing, and praising the stones.

प्रैते वदंतु प्र वयं वदाम ग्रावभ्यो वाचं वदता वदद्भ्यः । यदद्रयः पर्वताः साकमाशवः श्लोकं घोषं भरथेंद्राय सोमिनः ॥ (*praite vadaṃtu pra vayaṃ vadāma grāvabhyo vācaṃ vadatā vadadbhyaḥ | yadadrayaḥ parvatāḥ sākamāśavaḥ ślokaṃ ghoṣaṃ bharatheṃdrāya sominaḥ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94-1)

Let these stones raise a praise in the form of sound. Let us too offer a fitting counter-praise to this praise. O stones, heavy and swift-moving, as soon as you recite your praise in the form of sound addressed to Indra, the Soma juice will surely be pressed by you.

एते वदंति शतवत्सहस्रवदभि क्रंदंति हरितेभिरासभीः । विष्ट्वी ग्रावाणः सुकृतः सुकृत्यया होतुश्चित्पूर्वे हविरद्यमाशत ॥ (*ete vadaṃti śatavatsahasravadabhi kraṃdaṃti haritebhirāsabhīḥ | viṣṭvī grāvāṇaḥ sukṛtaḥ sukṛtyayā hotuścitpūrve haviradyamāśata ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94-2)

These stones make a deep sound from their green-coloured mouths, like the deep sound that arises when thousands of people gather and shout. Keeping the sacrifice under their own control, they receive the oblation even before Agni, the divine hotṛ.

सुपर्णा वाचमक्रतोप द्यव्याखरे कृष्णा इषीरा अनर्तिषुः । न्य १ ज्ञयंत्युपरस्य निष्कृतं पुरू रेतो दधिरे सूर्यश्वितः ॥ (*suparṇā vācamakratopa dyavyākhare kṛṣṇā iṣīrā anartiṣuḥ | nya 1 jñayaṃtyuparasya niṣkṛtaṃ purū reto dadhire sūryaśvitaḥ ‖*)

(10-94-5)

These stones, moving softly, make a sound in the atmosphere. They rejoice in the courtyard as a black antelope dances. They press out a juice that shines like the sun.

ध्रुवा एव वः पितरो युगेयुगे क्षेमकामासः सदसो न युंजते । अजुर्यासो हरिषाचो हरिद्रव आ द्यां रवेण पृथिवीमशुश्रवुः ॥ (*dhruvā eva vaḥ pitaro yugeyuge kṣemakāmāsaḥ sadaso na yuṃjate | ajuryāso hariṣāco haridrava ā dyāṃ raveṇa pṛthivīmaśuśravuḥ ||*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94-12)

O stones, your fathers the mountains, desiring peace for themselves, used to remain apart (विवक्त (*vivakta*)), taking no share in the assembly. Ageless, and satisfied by obtaining Soma, they used to spread their soft sounds through all of heaven and earth and make them echo.

तदिद्वदंत्यद्रयो विमोचने यामन्नंजस्पा इव फेदुपब्बिभिः । वसंतो बीजमिव धान्याकृतः पृंचंति सोमं न मिनंति बप्सतः ॥ (*tadidvadaṃtyadrayo vimocane yāmannaṃjaspā iva phedupabbibhiḥ | vasaṃto bījamiva dhānyākṛtaḥ pṛṃcaṃti somaṃ na minaṃti bapsataḥ ||*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94-13)

At the time of pressing these stones, like chariots moving swiftly on the road, and like farmers sowing seed who raise a cry of joy, press out the Soma juice sounding deeply and attractively. And they do no harm at all. In this way the praise of the ग्राव (*grāva*) runs. This praise also takes the form of a description of the ग्राव (*grāva*). And before reciting the last mantra, सुते अध्वरे (*sute adhvare*), the priest called Grāvastut recites the sūkta 10-76, which begins with the mantra आ व ऋंजस ऊर्जां (*ā va ṛṃjasa ūrjāṃ*), and the sūkta 10-175, which begins with the mantra प्र वो ग्रावाणः (*pra vo grāvāṇaḥ*) quoted above. And at the beginning or in the middle, as the occasion suits, he recites the Pāvamānī mantras until the pressing is finished. On all these occasions there is praise and description of the ग्राव (*grāva*). Although the present mantra is addressed to heaven and earth, the ग्राव (*grāva*) held ready for pressing the Soma at the time of their prayer is also praised.

सुमेके(*sumeke*)—This word is an epithet of heaven and earth. Sāyaṇa has explained it as "of good form". In many contexts it comes to mean "of good state" or "of unshakable nature". In some places it is understood as "of excellent action", or "skilled in service". When this word is an epithet of heaven and earth, it becomes स्वकीयाभिः प्रकाशयुक्ते (*svakīyābhiḥ prakāśayukte*), that is, "self-luminous with their own radiance", as Sāyaṇa has explained in mantras such as Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-15-5.

मनीषा (*manīṣā*)—It means "by speech in the form of praise". Its further meanings have been given in the special topics of the first ṛk of this same sūkta.

रोदसी (*rodasī*)—The further meanings of this word have been given in the special topics of the ṛk Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-56-7.

The words भूरिवाराः (*bhūrivārāḥ*), दर्शताः (*darśatāḥ*), यजत्राः (*yajatrāḥ*) are epithets of the flames of Agni and describe the divine nature of those flames. The greatness of Agni's flame will be given in the special topics of the next mantra.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

या ते॑ जि॒ह्वा मधु॑मती सुमे॒धा अग्ने॑ दे॒वेषू॒च्यत॑ उरू॒ची ।
तये॒ह विश्वाँ॒ अव॑से॒ यज॑त्रा॒ना सा॑दय पा॒यया॑ चा॒ मधू॑नि ॥ ५ ॥

> *yā te jihvā madhumatī sumedhā agne deveṣūcyata urūcī |*
> *tayeha viśvā~ avase yajatrānā sādaya pāyayā cā madhūni ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> या । ते । जिह्वा । मधुमती । सुमेधाः । अग्ने । देवेषु । उच्यते । उरूची ।
> तया । इह । विश्वान् । अवसे । यजत्रान् । आ । सादय । पायय । च । मधूनि ॥

> *yā | te | jihvā | madhumatī | sumedhāḥ | agne | deveṣu | ucyate | urūcī |*
> *tayā | iha | viśvān | avase | yajatrān | ā | sādaya | pāyaya | ca | madhūni ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ते तव मधुमत्युदकवती सुमेधाः । शोभना मेधा प्रज्ञा
> येॅस्स्याः सा । सर्वस्य ज्ञापयित्रि या जिह्वा ज्वालोरूची बहुव्याप्तिः सती देवेषु
> मध्य आह्वानार्थमुच्यते प्रेर्यते तया जिह्वया यजत्रान्यजनीयान्विश्वान्देवानिह
> कर्मण्यस्माकमवसे रक्षणाया सादय । उपवेशय । किंच तान्विश्वानेवान्मधूनि
> मदकरान् सोमान्पायय ॥ सुमेधाः । नित्यमसिच् प्रजामेधयोरित्यसिच् ।
> उच्यते । वच परिभाषणे । कर्मणि यकि रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । उरूची
> अंचतेः क्विन् । अंचतेश्चोपसंख्यानमिति जीप् । अनुदात्तस्य च यत्रोदात्तलोप
> इति जीप उदात्तत्वं । पायय । पा पान इत्यस्य णौ परतः शाच्छासाह्वान्नावेषां
> युगिति युक् । तिजि उत्तरत्वादनिघातः ॥

> *he agne te tava madhumatyudakavatī sumedhāḥ | śobhanā medhā prajñā*
> *yèssyāḥ sā | sarvasya jñāpayitri yā jihvā jvālorūcī bahuvyāptiḥ satī deveṣu*
> *madhya āhvānārthamucyate preryate tayā jihvayā yajatrānyajanīyānviśvāndevāniha*
> *karmaṇyasmākamavase rakṣaṇāyā sādaya | upaveśaya | kiṃca tānviśvānevānmadhūni*
> *madakarān somānpāyaya ‖ sumedhāḥ | nityamasic prajāmedhayorityasic |*
> *ucyate | vaca paribhāṣaṇe | karmaṇi yaki rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | urūcī*
> *aṃcateḥ kvin | aṃcateścopasaṃkhyānamiti jīp | anudāttasya ca yatrodāttalopa*
> *iti jīpa udāttatvaṃ | pāyaya | pā pāna ityasya ṇau parataḥ śācchāsāhvānnāveṣāṃ*
> *yugiti yuk | tiji uttaratvādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, your tongue is honeyed (मधुमती (*madhumatī*)), that is, watery, and of good wisdom (सुमेधाः (*sumedhāḥ*)): she who has good insight, who makes all know. That tongue, the flame, being widely pervading (उरूची (*urūcī*)), is sent forth (उच्यते (*ucyate*)) among the gods to summon them. With that tongue seat (आ सादय (*ā sādaya*)) here, in our rite, for our protection, all the gods who are worthy of worship (यजत्रान् (*yajatrān*)). And further, make those same gods drink the Soma juices (मधूनि (*madhūni*)), the intoxicating ones.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ते (*te*)—your
- मधुमती (*madhumatī*)—watery (sweet)
- सुमेधाः (*sumedhāḥ*)—that which gives to all the knowledge (of duty)
- या जिह्वा (*yā jihvā*)—the tongue that there is
- उरूची (*urūcī*)—having the power to pervade widely
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among the gods
- उच्यते (*ucyate*)—is renowned
- तया (*tayā*)—with the help of that tongue
- यजत्रान् (*yajatrān*)—those worthy of the sacrifice
- विश्वान् (*viśvān*)—all the gods
- इह (*iha*)—in this rite
- अवसे (*avase*)—for our protection
- आ सादय (*ā sādaya*)—seat
- मधूनि (*madhūni*)—the sweet Soma juice
- पायय (*pāyaya*)—make (them) drink

Gist

O Agni, your tongue, which is watery and makes known to all the knowledge of duty, is renowned among the gods as having the power to pervade widely. With the help of that tongue, seat all the gods who are worthy of the sacrifice, in this rite, for our protection, and make them drink the sweet Soma juice.

English translation

With your wide-spreading tongue, Agni, sweet and intelligent, which is renowned amongst the gods, bring hither all the adorable deities for our protection, and give them to drink of the sweet (libation).

Special Topics

This mantra contains praise of the flame of Agni. मधुमती (*madhumatī*) and सुमेधाः (*sumedhāḥ*) are epithets of जिह्वा (*jihvā*). उरुची (*urucī*) also makes known the greatness of the flame.

मधुमती (*madhumatī*)—a flame accompanied by मधु (*madhu*). What is मधु (*madhu*)? Here it is explained as "water". The word मधु (*madhu*) is read among the names of water (Ni. 1-12). मधुमती (*madhumatī*) means "that which is accompanied by water". The description of Agni as born of water is well known from epithets such as अपां नपात् (*apāṃ napāt*) and अपांगर्भः (*apāṃgarbhaḥ*). The praise of the water-filled flame of Agni at times of sacrifice carries a special meaning in the Brāhmaṇas and elsewhere. The distinctive character of this description is understood from some examples.

समिधं प्रास्याभिजुहोत्यग्नेरनीकमप आ विवेशापां नपात्पतिरक्षन्नसुर्यं । (*samidhaṃ prāsyābhijuhotyagneranīkamapa ā viveśāpāṃ napātpatirakṣannasuryaṃ |*)

(Vā. Saṃ. 8-24)

O Agni, in the form of Apāṃnapāt, the waters are your face. To escape the onslaught of the Rākṣasas I have entered the waters, which are your face. Be gracious. Thus an identity between the face of Agni and the waters is stated. In some places, when the relation between Agni and the waters is shown, only the physical relation is shown. A more hidden relation is also indicated. At the time of building the fire-altar the priests, absorbed in meditation, grasp the nature of the waters and describe it in this way.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

या ते॑ अग्ने॒ पर्व॑तस्येव॒ धारास॑श्चन्ती पी॒पय॑द्देव चि॒त्रा ।
ताम॒स्मभ्यं॒ प्रम॑तिं जातवेदो॒ वसो॒ रास्व॑ सुम॒तिं वि॒श्वज॑न्याम् ॥ ६ ॥

> *yā te agne parvatasyeva dhārāsaścantī pīpayaddeva citrā |*
> *tāmasmabhyaṃ pramatiṃ jātavedo vaso rāsva sumatiṃ viśvajanyām ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> या । ते । अग्ने । पर्वतस्य इव । धारा । असश्चंती । पीपयत् । देव । चित्रा !
> तां । अस्मभ्यं । प्रमतिं । जातवेदः । वसो इति । रास्व । सु ; मतिं । विश्वजन्यां ॥

> *yā | te | agne | parvatasya iva | dhārā | asaścaṃtī | pīpayat | deva | citrā !*
> *tāṃ | asmabhyaṃ | pramatiṃ | jātavedaḥ | vaso iti | rāsva | su ; matiṃ | viśvajanyāṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देव दीप्यमान हे अग्ने चित्रा नानारूपासश्चंत्यस्मदन्यत्र संगतिमकुर्वाणा
> या ते तव प्रमतिः प्रकृष्टा बुद्धिः पीपयत् अपेक्षितफलदानेनास्मान्वर्धयति । तत्र
> दृष्टांतः । पर्वतस्येव धारा । यथा पर्वतस्य मेघस्योदकधारौषधिवनस्पत्यादिषु
> संगतिं कुर्वाणा तान्वर्धयति तद्वत् । वसो सर्वस्य वासयितर्जातवेदो जातप्रज्ञ हे अग्ने तां
> प्रमतिं परहितकरणसमर्थां बुद्धिमस्सभ्यं रास्व । दत्त्व । तथा
> विश्वजन्यां सर्वजनहितां सुमतिं शोभनां बुद्धिं दत्त्व ॥ असश्चंती । सश्चतिर्गतिकर्मा ।
> शतर्युगितश्चेति जीप् । नञा समासे नञ्परः । पीपयत् । पा पाने ।
> ण्यंतस्य लुजि चचें रूपं । चच्यन्यतरस्यामिति चचि परतः पूर्वस्कोदात्तत्वं ।
> यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । प्रमतिं । तादौ च निति कृत्यशाविति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं ।
> रास्व । रा दाने । व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदु । लोटि रूपं । आमंत्रितस्याविद्यमानत्वान्निघाताभावः ॥

> *deva dīpyamāna he agne citrā nānārūpāsaścaṃtyasmadanyatra saṃgatimakurvāṇā*
> *yā te tava pramatiḥ prakṛṣṭā buddhiḥ pīpayat apekṣitaphaladānenāsmānvardhayati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | parvatasyeva dhārā | yathā parvatasya meghasyodakadhārauṣadhivanaspatyādiṣu saṃgatiṃ kurvāṇā tānvardhayati tadvat | vaso sarvasya vāsayitarjātavedo jātaprajña he agne tāṃ pramatiṃ parahitakaraṇasamarthāṃ buddhimassabhyaṃ rāsva | dattva | tathā viśvajanyāṃ sarvajanahitāṃ sumatiṃ śobhanāṃ buddhiṃ dattva ‖*
> *asaścaṃtī | saścatirgatikarmā | śataryugitaśceti jīp | nañjā samāse nañparaḥ | pīpayat | pā pāne |*
> *ṇyaṃtasya luji cacè rūpaṃ | cacyanyatarasyāmiti caci parataḥ pūrvaskodāttatvaṃ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | pramatiṃ | tādau ca niti kṛtyaśāviti gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ |*
> *rāsva | rā dāne | vyatyayenātmanepadu | loṭi rūpaṃ | āmaṃtritasyāvidyamānatvānnighātābhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

O shining Agni! Your wisdom (pramati), of many forms and not consorting with anyone other than us, nourishes us by giving the desired fruit. The illustration: like the stream of a mountain, that is, as the water-stream of a cloud, joining the plants, trees and so on, makes them grow. O Vasu, who causes all to dwell, O Jātaveda, of born wisdom, Agni, give us that wisdom, able to do good to others; and likewise give a good wisdom (sumati), beneficial to all people. असश्चंती (*asaścaṃtī*): the root saśc means movement; पीपयत् (*pīpayat*) from the root pā (to drink); रास्व (*rāsva*) from rā (to give), a middle-voice form by vyatyaya. (The accent remarks are omitted.)

Word-to-word meaning

- देव अग्ने (*deva agne*)—O shining Agni!
- चित्रा (*citrā*)—of many forms
- असश्चंती (*asaścaṃtī*)—not moving elsewhere (leaving us)
- या ते (*yā te*)—your wisdom of favour, which

- पर्वतस्य (*parvatasya*)—of the cloud
- धारा इव (*dhārā iva*)—as the stream in the form of rain makes plants and the rest grow
- पीपयत् (*pīpayat*)—nourishes us and makes us grow
- वसो (*vaso*)—O causer of dwelling for all
- जातवेदः (*jātavedaḥ*)—O Agni of born wisdom
- तां प्रमतिं (*tāṃ pramatiṃ*)—that same wisdom of favour
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—in us
- रास्व (*rāsva*)—place
- विश्वजन्यां (*viśvajanyāṃ*)—beneficial to all
- सुमतिं (*sumatiṃ*)—excellent wisdom: grant it

Gist

O Agni, shining, causer of dwelling, of born wisdom! Your wisdom of favour, of many forms and moving nowhere else away from us, nourishes us and makes us grow, as the rain-stream of the cloud makes plants and the rest grow. Set that wisdom, which brings good to all, on our side.

English translation

Divine Agni, giver of dwellings, knower of all that exists. extend to us that bencvolence which, unshared by others, cherishes us like the showers of the rain-cloud ; that kindness which is beneficent for all mankind.

Special Topics

जातवेदाः (*jātavedāḥ*)—Having cited the Nirukta explanation जातानि वेद, जातानि वैनं विदुः (*jātāni veda, jātāni vainaṃ viduḥ*) and so on, it was explained earlier how the name Jātavedas suits Agni (Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, part 8, p. 161-1).

सुमतिं (*sumatiṃ*)—प्रमतिं (*pramatiṃ*): two kinds of distinction are shown in wisdom. The word pramati is explained as excellent wisdom and sumati as good wisdom,

वसो (*vaso*)—Sāyaṇa takes the word as meaning one called vasu because he causes all to dwell. It was shown in the special topics of the 2nd Ṛk of this same sūkta that, being all-pervading, he may also be denoted by the word vasu. Where Agni is said to be joined with the Vasus, they are indicated as different deities; but since in many places the all-pervading Agni, Āditya and the Vasus are said to be identical, the epithet vasu for Agni is fitting.

it may be said that the word pramati indicates the power of knowledge useful for grasping the meaning of principles, and sumati the moral power of action needed for excellent conduct of rites.

पर्वतस्य धारा इव (*parvatasya dhārā iva*)—In this simile the word parvata is explained as cloud. How the meaning "cloud" suits parvata is a matter to be considered. In the Ṛk Saṃhitā the word parvata is used mostly in sūktas addressed to Indra and to the Maruts. The current meaning is famous as "mountain"; the question is what is the basis for explaining it as cloud. Yāska's explanation is:

पर्ववान् पर्वतः ; पर्व पुनः प्रणातेः प्रीणातीर्वा (*parvavān parvataḥ ; parva punaḥ praṇāteḥ prīṇātīrvā*) (Ni. 1-20)

Parvata is that which has joints (parva). The word parva is formed from the root pṛ, meaning "fill", or from the root prī, meaning "satisfy". The etymologists' explanation is that what has such a parva is parvata. According to this, there is no objection to a cloud being named parvata, either because clouds fill the empty sky or because through rain they satisfy the world. The same word is used in many places as an epithet of giri.

आश्मानं चित्सर्वं १ पर्वतं गिरिं प्र च्यावयंति यामभिः । (*āśmānaṃ citsarvaṃ 1 parvataṃ giriṃ pra cyāvayaṃti yāmabhiḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-56-4)

त्यं चित्पर्वतं गिरिं शतवंतं सहस्रिणं । वि स्तोतृभ्यो रुरोजिथ ॥ (*tyaṃ citparvataṃ giriṃ śatavaṃtaṃ sahasriṇaṃ* | *vi stotṛbhyo rurojitha* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-64-5)

In these places parvata is an epithet of giri. Of these, in the first it is explained as उदकवान् मेघः (*udakavān meghaḥ*), a cloud able to fill the world with water, and in the second as पर्ववान् गिरिः (*parvavān giriḥ*), a cloud having joints.

In the Nighaṇṭu parvata, adri and giri are all read among the names of cloud (Ni. 1-10). Sāyaṇa, on Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-56-4, says the word giri is formed from the root gṛ, निगिरत्युदकमिति गिरिः (*nigiratyudakamiti giriḥ*): the cloud is called giri because it pours out water; and that the word adri is formed from the root ad (2-165-4). Since Indra is described as splitting all these with his thunderbolt and releasing water, cloud must be the well-known meaning of all of them in the Ṛk Saṃhitā. But that the original meaning of all the words is the common "mountain" is also known from many sources.

वि वृत्रं पर्वशो ययुर्वि पर्वता अराजिनः । चक्राणा वृष्टि पौंस्यं ॥ (*vi vṛtraṃ parvaśo yayurvi parvatā arājinaḥ | cakrāṇā vṛṣṭi pauṃsyaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-7-23)

Here Indra struck with his thunderbolt and split these mountains, lightless and full of darkness; so it is understood that the word parvata denoted the mass of darkness. This mass of darkness is the cloud.

But to explain the word parvata everywhere simply as cloud would not be proper either. For after Indra's victory there are four kinds of attainment: 1) release of the cows; 2) unobstructed flow of the waters; 3) appearance of the dawn; 4) sunrise. These four are what occurs after Indra's victory. Therefore explaining parvata merely as cloud is possible only in some contexts.

स मातरा सूर्येणा कवीनामवासयद्रुजदद्रिं गृणानः ॥ (*sa mātarā sūryeṇā kavīnāmavāsayadrujadadriṃ gṛṇānaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-32-2)

In such places it says that having split the adri he caused the sunlight and spread it over heaven and earth. Here the word adri is explained as parvata, but not the mountain commonly so called; so it must be explained as a mass of darkness resembling a mountain. Similarly:

महांतमिंद्र पर्वतं वि यद्वः सृजो सि धारा अव धानवं हन् ॥ (*mahāṃtamiṃdra parvataṃ vi yadvaḥ sṛjo si dhārā ava dhānavaṃ han ‖*) (Saṃ. 5-32-1)

The mountain that holds back the water must be explained as the dark cloud. The sense fits if it is the deep cloud standing in the atmosphere, as in:

शिशुं नदीनागं् हरिमदिबुध्नमिति गिरिर्वा अद्रिगिरिबुध्ना उ वा आपः ॥ (*śiśuṃ nadīnāgṃ harimadibudhnamiti girirvā adrigiribudhnā u vā āpaḥ ǁ*) (Śa. Brā. 7-5-2-18)

This supports the idea stated in the Brāhmaṇa passage that the water, the embryo of that Varuṇa's horse which was earlier called the Sun's rays (वारुणो ना अश्वः (*vāruṇo nā aśvaḥ*)), rests at the base of the adri. This darkness, dense like a mountain and pervasive, holds back the water and the sun's rays (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-16 6; 8). Its use in this very sense of "full of darkness" is seen in many other places. For example,

त्वमपापसिधानावृणोरपाधारयः पर्वते दानुमद्वसु । (*tvamapāpasidhānāvṛṇorapādhārayaḥ parvate dānumadvasu* |) (Pa. Saṃ. 102-4)?182

Many places describe how Indra (Indra in the form of the Sun), with his shining rays, set all the mountains in motion and made the hidden Sun shine; in them the meaning must be taken as stated above. Passages such as "शिशुं नदीनां हरिमद्रिबुद्धं (*śiśuṃ nadīnāṃ harimadribuddhaṃ*)" (Vā. Saṃ. 13-82) also support this meaning.

Just as the word parvata is used to denote a mass of darkness and its density, so it is used also to denote a mass of light, the opposite of darkness. For example,

प्राक्तादपाक्तादधरादुदक्तादभि जहि रक्षसः पर्वतेन । (*prāktādapāktādadharādudaktādabhi jahi rakṣasaḥ parvatena* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-104-9)

In such places the explanation पर्ववान् पर्वतः (*parvavān parvataḥ*) is given. Here "thunderbolt" is the meaning, that is, a mass of light. If the word parvata is formed from the root prī, as in the etymologists' second explanation, it may also have been used in the sense of friends who give pleasure. For example,

अस्मे रुद्रा मेहना पर्वतासो वृत्रहत्ये भरहूत् सजोषाः ॥ (*asme rudrā mehanā parvatāso vṛtrahatye bharahūt sajoṣāḥ ǁ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-63-12)

Here the Maruts are Indra's friends. Because they helped Indra in battle and in slaying Vṛtra, they became dear to him. Therefore they are denoted by the word parvata. Sāyaṇa explains the sense of this word: पर्वतसद्वशाः पूरणवंतः प्रीणनवंतो वा मरुतः । (*parvatasadvaśāḥ pūraṇavaṃtaḥ prīṇanavaṃto vā marutaḥ* |)

There are contexts where parvata is understood as a particular luminous deity. For example,

प्रोतये वरुणं मित्रमिंद्रं मरुतः कृष्वावसे नो अद्य । प्र पूषणं विष्णुमग्निं पुरंधिं सवितारमोषधीः पर्वतांश्च ॥ (*protaye varuṇaṃ mitramiṃdraṃ marutaḥ kṛṣvāvase no adya | pra pūṣaṇaṃ viṣṇumagniṃ puraṃdhiṃ savitāramoṣadhīḥ parvatāṃśca ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-21-9)

शं नः पर्वता ध्रुवयो भवंतु शं नः सिंधवः शमु सन्त्वापः ॥ (*śaṃ naḥ parvatā dhruvayo bhavaṃtu śaṃ naḥ siṃdhavaḥ śamu santvāpaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-35-8)

In all such places the parvatas too are prayed to for favour along with deities such as Indra and Mitra; it is prayed that the mountains be pleasant to us. In such contexts Sāyaṇa explains: पर्वतान् अद्रीन् इत्येतान् देवान् । (*parvatān adrīn ityetān devān* |) the deities called parvata are joined with Indra and the other deities and prayed to for our protection. But in places such as न पर्वता न नद्यः (*na parvatā na nadyaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-55-7) he explains it as the earthly mountain. In contexts such as ध्रुवा ह पर्वता इमे (*dhruvā ha parvatā ime*) (Tai. Brā. 2-4-28) and पर्वत इवाविचाचलिः (*parvata ivāvicācaliḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-173-2), too, the simile is of the earthly mountain, firmly established.

In the verse under discussion, the comparisons beginning with धारा इव (*dhārā iva*) support the meaning "cloud" itself.

विश्वजन्या (*viśvajanyā*)—beneficial to all people. It is an adjective of the word सुमतिं (*sumatiṃ*), "excellent understanding": an understanding that brings welfare to everyone. The word जन्य (*janya*) is used in three senses. First, formed from the root जन् (*jan*), it means "fit for birth"; this is the conventional sense. In passages such as पात्पतिर्जन्यादंहसो नो मित्रः (*pātpatirjanyādaṃhaso no mitraḥ*) (4-55-5) the word जन्य (*janya*) denotes what is connected with people; the prayer there is "free us from the sin connected with people". Besides this, जन्य (*janya*) denotes what is beneficial to people. In contexts such as जनंजनं जन्यो नातिमन्यते (*janaṃjanaṃ janyo nātimanyate*) (10-91-2), जन्य (*janya*) means "beneficial to people". The same meaning must be stated for विश्वजन्यां (*viśvajanyāṃ*).

स आ यजस्व नृवतीरनु क्षाः स्वार्हा इषः क्षुमतीर्विश्वदन्याः ॥ (*sa ā yajasva nṛvatīranu kṣāḥ svārhā iṣaḥ kṣumatīrviśvadanyāḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-2-6)

The sense is: offer to the gods food that is a means to the welfare of all people. In the same way, in the present verse too the purport of the word विश्वजन्य (*viśvajanya*) must be stated as "what brings welfare to all people".

विश्वजन्यां सुमतिं (*viśvajanyām sumatiṃ*)—in the prayer "grant a good understanding that brings welfare to all", a vision of the welfare of the world is indicated: not looking only to one's own selfish good, but that the whole world may find well-being.

Sūkta 58 (Maṇḍala 3)

> धेनुः प्रत्नस्येति नवर्चं पंचमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रिष्टुभमाश्विनं । तथा
> चानुक्रांतं । धेनुर्नवाश्विनमिति ॥ प्रातरनुवाक आश्विनक्रत् त्रिष्टुभे छंदस्याश्विन
> शस्त्रे चास्य सूक्तस्य विनियोगः । सूत्रितं च । धेनु: प्रत्नस्य क उ श्रवदिति सूक्ते ।
> आ. ४–१५ । इति ॥ व्यूक्षे दशरात्रे द्वितीये छंदोमे प्रउगशस्त्रेयमाश्विनश्च
> तुर्थस्तृचः । द्वितीयस्याग्निं व इति खंडे सूत्रितं । धेनुः प्रत्नस्य काम्यं दुहाना
> ब्रह्माण इंद्रोप याहि विद्वान् । आ. ८–१० । इति ।

> *dhenuḥ pratnasyeti navarcaṃ paṃcamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ triṣṭubhamāśvinaṃ | tathā*
> *cānukrāṃtaṃ | dhenurnavāśvinamiti ‖ prātaranuvāka āśvinakrat triṣṭubhe chaṃdasyāśvina*
> *śastre cāsya sūktasya viniyogaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | dhenu: pratnasya ka u śravaditi sūkte |*
> *ā. 4-15 | iti ‖ vyūkṣe daśarātre dvitīye chaṃdome praugaśastreyamāśvinaśca*
> *turthastṛcaḥ | dvitīyasyāgniṃ va iti khaṃḍe sūtritaṃ | dhenuḥ pratnasya kāmyaṃ duhānā*
> *brahmāṇa iṃdropa yāhi vidvān | ā. 8-10 | iti |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning धेनुः प्रत्नस्य (*dhenuḥ pratnasya*) is the fifth sūkta, of nine verses. Its seer is Viśvāmitra, its deity the Aśvins, its metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇī says धेनुर्नवाश्विनमिति (*dhenurnavāśvinamiti*). The sūkta is applied in the Prātaranuvāka, in the Āśvina-kratu, to the Āśvina-śastra in the Triṣṭubh metre. The sūtra says: धेनु: प्रत्नस्य क उ श्रवदिति सूक्ते (*dhenu: pratnasya ka u śravaditi sūkte*) (Ā. Sū. 4-15). Further, in the Vyūḍha Daśarātra, in the second Chandoma, in the Prauga-śastra, the fourth tṛca (set of three verses) is the Āśvina one; the sūtra in the khaṇḍa beginning द्वितीयस्याग्निं व (*dvitīyasyāgniṃ va*) reads धेनुः प्रत्नस्य काम्यं दुहाना ब्रह्माण इंद्रोप याहि विद्वान् (*dhenuḥ pratnasya kāmyaṃ duhānā brahmāṇa iṃdropa yāhi vidvān*) (Ā. Sū. 8-10).

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning धेनुः प्रत्नस्य (*dhenuḥ pratnasya*) is the fifth sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has nine ṛks. Viśvāmitra is its seer; the Aśvins are its deity; Triṣṭubh is its metre. In the Anukramaṇī it is described as धेनुर्नवाश्विनं (*dhenurnavāśvinaṃ*). At the time of reciting the mantras of the Prātaranuvāka, this sūkta is applied to the Āśvina-śastra mantras in the Triṣṭubh metre belonging to the Āśvina-kratu; this is set out by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra धेनुः प्रत्नस्य क उ श्रवदिति सूक्ते (*dhenuḥ pratnasya ka u śravaditi sūkte*) (Ā. 4-15). And in the Daśarātra sacrifice called Vyūḍha, in the second Chandoma, among the Prauga-śastra mantras, the first three ṛks of this sūkta are applied to the fourth tṛca (tṛca means three ṛks), which has the Aśvins as deity; this is set out in the khaṇḍa द्वितीयस्याग्निं व (*dvitīyasyāgniṃ va*) of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra by the sūtra धेनुः प्रत्नस्य काम्यं दुहाना ब्रह्माण इंद्रोप याहि विद्वान् (*dhenuḥ pratnasya kāmyaṃ duhānā brahmāṇa iṃdropa yāhi vidvān*) (Ā. 8-10).

Sūkta 58

Maṇḍala 3 · Anuvāka 5 · Sūkta 58

Aṣṭaka 3 · Adhyāya 4 · Varga 3, 4

Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 9

Seer: Viśvāmitra

Deity: the Aśvins

Metre: Triṣṭubh

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

धे॒नुः प्र॒त्नस्य॒ काम्यं॒ दुहा॑ना॒न्तः पु॒त्रश्च॑रति॒ दक्षि॑णायाः ।
आ द्यो॑त॒निं व॑हति शु॒भ्रया॑मो॒षस॒ः स्तोमो॑ अ॒श्विना॑वजीगः ॥ १ ॥

> *dhenuḥ pratnasya kāmyaṃ duhānāntaḥ putraścarati dakṣiṇāyāḥ |*
> *ā dyotaniṃ vahati śubhrayāmoṣasaḥ stomo aśvināvajīgaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> धेनुः । प्रत्नस्य । काम्यं । दुहाना । अंतरिति । पुत्रः । च र ति । दक्षिणायाः ।
> आ । द्योतनिं । वहति । शुभ्रयामा । उषसः । स्तोमः । अश्विनौ । अजीगरिति ॥ १ ॥

> *dhenuḥ | pratnasya | kāmyaṃ | duhānā | aṃtariti | putraḥ | ca ra ti | dakṣiṇāyāḥ |*
> *ā | dyotaniṃ | vahati | śubhrayāmā | uṣasaḥ | stomaḥ | aśvinau | ajīgariti ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> धेनुः प्रीणयित्रुषाः प्रत्नस्य पुरातनस्याग्नेः काम्यं कमनीयं पयो
> दुहाना । दोग्ध्रि भवति । दक्षिणाया उषसः पुत्रः सूरस्तस्या अंतश्चरति ! उषसोऽनंतरं
> शुभ्रयामा । सूर्यकिरणसंपर्काच्छुभ्रतया गमनं यस्यासौ शुभ्रयामा दिवसः । द्योतनिं सर्वस्य
> प्रकाशकं सूर्यमा वहति । बिभर्ति । अत उषसः
> पुराश्विन् स्तोतुं स्तोमः स्तोत्रकारी होत्रादिरजीगः । जागर्ति । उत्तिष्ठति ॥
> शुभ्रयामा । या प्रापणे । आतो मनिन् । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । अजीग ।
> जागृ निद्राक्षये । लजतिष्यदादित्वाच्छपो लुक् । आकारस्येकारश्छांदसः । गुणे कृते
> हल्ड्यादिना तिपो लोपः ॥

> *dhenuḥ prīṇayitruṣāḥ pratnasya purātanasyāgneḥ kāmyaṃ kamanīyaṃ payo*
> *duhānā | dogdri bhavati | dakṣiṇāyā uṣasaḥ putraḥ sūrastasyā aṃtaścarati ! uṣaso 'naṃtaraṃ śubhrayāmā |*

> *sūryakiraṇasaṃparkācchubhratayā gamanaṃ yasyāsau śubhrayāmā divasaḥ | dyotaniṃ sarvasya prakāśakaṃ sūryamā vahati | bibharti | ata uṣasaḥ*
> *purāśvin stotuṃ stomaḥ stotrakārī hotrādirajīgaḥ | jāgarti | uttiṣṭhati ‖*
> *śubhrayāmā | yā prāpaṇe | āto manin | bahuprīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | ajīga |*
> *jāgṛ nidrākṣaye | lajatiṣyadāditvācchapo luk | ākārasyekāraścāṃdasaḥ | guṇe kṛte*
> *halbyādinā tipo lopaḥ ‖*

Summary

धेनुः (*dhenuḥ*) is the one who gratifies, Uṣas. She yields (दुहाना (*duhānā*), a milker) the desirable milk of ancient Agni. The son of the southern Uṣas, the sun, moves within her. After Uṣas comes the "bright-coursed" one (शुभ्रयामा (*śubhrayāmā*)), the day, whose going is bright through contact with the sun's rays. It bears (वहति (*vahati*), "carries") the illuminator of all, the sun. Therefore the praiser (स्तोमः (*stomaḥ*)), the hotṛ and others, wakes (अजीगः (*ajīgaḥ*), "is awake, rises") in order to praise the Aśvins before Uṣas.

Word-to-word meaning

- धेनुः (*dhenuḥ*)—Uṣas, the goddess who gives joy to the world
- प्रत्नस्य (*pratnasya*)—for the ancient Agni
- काम्यं (*kāmyaṃ*)—the desired age (vayas)?183
- दुहाना (*duhānā*)—she milks
- दक्षिणायाः (*dakṣiṇāyāḥ*)—of Uṣas
- पुत्रः (*putraḥ*)—the son, the sun
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the atmosphere
- चरति (*carati*)—he moves
- शुभ्रयामा (*śubhrayāmā*)—the day lit up by the sun's rays
- द्योतनिं (*dyotaniṃ*)—the sun, the illuminator of all
- आ वहति (*ā vahati*)—it bears
- उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*)—before the appearance of Uṣas
- अश्विनौ (*aśvinau*)—to praise the Aśvins
- स्तोमः (*stomaḥ*)—the praiser
- अजीगः (*ajīgaḥ*)—wakes

Gist

Uṣas, who gives joy to the world, milks the desired age for ancient Agni. The sun, son of Uṣas, moves in the atmosphere. The day, lit up by the sun's rays, bears the sun, the illuminator of all. Before the appearance of Uṣas the praiser wakes in order to praise the Aśvins.

English translation

The milch-cow (the dawn) yields the desired milk to the ancient (Agni); the son of the south passes within (the firmament) ; the bright- houred (day) brings the illuminative (sun) : the praiser awakes to (glory) the Ashwins preceding the dawn.

Special Topics

This mantra describes the relation of Uṣas to the sacrificial fire, how the world is lit by the sun's radiance as soon as Uṣas appears, and also the companionship of Uṣas with the Aśvins. Because Uṣas gives joy to the world, she is denoted by the word धेनु (*dhenu*)

(cow). The special meaning suggested by the word धेनु (*dhenu*) has been stated earlier. Here the word is used to show the relation between Agni and Uṣas. Or it may be said that just as she is a cause of growth for Agni, so through Agni she is a cause of growth for the world. There is no doubt that the world gets still greater joy from the sight of Uṣas than the calf gets from the sight of the cow. Darkness is destroyed, and not only physical darkness: the darkness of ignorance too is destroyed. Along with the delight that comes from seeing with the eye, delight of the self is also gained. Since she gives satisfaction in many ways, it is quite proper that she is denoted by the word धेनु (*dhenu*). She is also described by the word दक्षिणायाः (*dakṣiṇāyāḥ*). And it is stated here that Āditya is her son; in the same way Agni too can be called her son. How the relation of mother and son holds between Uṣas and Āditya and Agni is also explained in many places.

ऋतवस्तेऽथ यः स भूतानां पतिः संवत्सरः सोऽथ या सोषाः पत्न्यौषसी सा तानीमानि भूतानि च भूतानां च पतिः संवत्सर उषसि रेतोऽसिंचन्त न संवत्सरे कुमारोऽजायत ॥ (*ṛtavaste 'tha yaḥ sa bhūtānāṃ patiḥ saṃvatsaraḥ so 'tha yā soṣāḥ patnyauṣasī sā tānīmāni bhūtāni ca bhūtānāṃ ca patiḥ saṃvatsara uṣasi reto 'siṃcanta na saṃvatsare kumāro 'jāyata ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 6-1-3-8)

The beings created by Prajāpati are the seasons. The lord of beings is the year. Uṣas is his wife. At first this year, lord of beings, and the seasons cast seed in Uṣas. Then a son was born. This boy is the one marked by the name Agni. Varieties of names suited to their natures became known for him. The relation of mother and son between Uṣas and Agni is suggested also in the present verse. In passages such as नक्तोषासा वर्णमामेम्याने धापयेते शिशुमेकं समाची (*naktoṣāsā varṇamāmemyāne dhāpayete śiśumekaṃ samācī*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-96-4), where Night and Uṣas together nourish one son common to both, this son may be either Agni or the sun. Through these sons she possesses the power to protect the world and the power to bestow wealth on the world. Therefore she is described by the epithet दक्षिणा (*dakṣiṇā*).

उदु श्रिय उषसो रोचमाना अस्तुरपां नोर्मयो रुशंतः कृणोति विश्वा सुपथा सुगान्यभूदु वस्वी दक्षिणा मघोनी ॥ (*udu śriya uṣaso rocamānā asturapāṃ normayo ruśaṃtaḥ kṛṇoti viśvā supathā sugānyabhūdu vasvī dakṣiṇā maghonī ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-64-1)

As soon as the rays of the radiant Uṣas spread over the universe like a flow of water, the world gets new vitality and becomes a bestower of wealth. For this very reason she is described by the epithets मघोनी (*maghonī*) and दक्षिणा (*dakṣiṇā*). All these points are suggested in the present verse.

सोमः (*somaḥ*)—this word means "praise".[?184]. In some contexts it is also used of the praiser.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सु॒युग्व॑हन्ति॒ प्रति॑ वामृ॒तेनो॒र्ध्वा भ॑वन्ति पि॒तरे॑व॒ मेधा॑◌ः ।
जरे॑थाम॒स्मद्वि प॒णेर्म॑नी॒षां यु॒वोरव॑श्चकृ॒मा या॑तम॒र्वाक् ॥ २ ॥

> *suyugvahanti prati vāmṛtenordhvā bhavanti pitareva medhāḥ |*
> *jarethāmasmadvi paṇermanīṣāṃ yuvoravaścakṛmā yātamarvāk ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सुयुक् । वहंति । प्रति । वां । ऋतेन । ऊर्ध्वाः । भवंति । पितरा इव । मेधाः ।
> जरेथां । अस्मत् । वि । पणेः । मनीषां । युवोः । अवः । चकृम । आ । यातं ।
> अर्वाक् ॥ २ ॥

> *suyuk | vahaṃti | prati | vāṃ | ṛtena | ūrdhvāḥ | bhavaṃti | pitarā iva | medhāḥ |*
> *jarethāṃ | asmat | vi | paṇeḥ | manīṣāṃ | yuvoḥ | avaḥ | cakṛma | ā | yātaṃ |*
> *arvāk ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अश्विनौ सुयुक् सुष्टु रथे योजिता अश्वा ऋतेन सत्यभूतेन रथेन वां युवां प्रति वहंति । यज्ञं प्रत्यागमनाय धारयंति । मेधा यज्ञाश्चोर्ध्वा युष्मदभिमुखमूर्ध्वा भवंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । पितरेव ' यथा पुत्राः पितर मातापितरावभिलक्ष्य गच्छंति तद्वत् । अस्मदस्मत्तः सकाशात्पणेर्मनीषामासुरीं बुद्धिं वि जरेथां । विशेषेण नाशयतं । वयं तु युवोर्युवयोरवो हनिर्लक्षणमन्नं चक्रम । कुर्मः । युवामर्वागस्मादाभिमुख्येना यातं ॥ सुयुक् । युजे क्विप् । सुपां सुलुगिति सुपो लुक् । पितरेव । पिता मात्रेति पितुः शेषः । सुपो डादेशः । जरेथां । ज्ञष वयोहान् । ण्यंतस्य जनीज्यष्ट सुरंजोऽमंताश्चेति मित्त्वाद्बृद्ध्यभावः । छंदस्युभयथेत्याधाम आर्धधातुकत्याणिलोपतः । शपः पिता ; दनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he aśvinau suyuk suṣṭu rathe yojitā aśvā ṛtena satyabhūtena rathena vāṃ*
> *yuvāṃ prati vahaṃti | yajñaṃ pratyāgamanāya dhārayaṃti | medhā*
> *yajñāścordhvā*
> *yuṣmadabhimukhamūrdhvā bhavaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | pitareva '*
> *yathā putrāḥ pitara mātāpitarāvabhilakṣya gacchaṃti tadvat |*
> *asmadasmattaḥ sakāśātpaṇermanīṣāmāsurīṃ buddhiṃ vi*
> *jarethāṃ | viśeṣeṇa nāśayataṃ | vayaṃ tu yuvoryuvayoravo*
> *hanirlakṣaṇamannaṃ*
> *cakrama | kurmaḥ | yuvāmarvāgasmādābhimukhyenā yātaṃ ‖ suyuk |*
> *yuje*
> *kvip | supāṃ sulugiti supo luk | pitareva | pitā mātreti pituḥ śeṣaḥ |*
> *supo*
> *ḍādeśaḥ | jarethāṃ | jñaṣa vayohān | ṇyaṃtasya janījyaṣṭa suraṃjo*
> *'maṃtāśveti*
> *mittvādvṛddhyabhāvaḥ | chaṃdasyubhayathetyādhāma*
> *ārdhadhātukatyāṇilopataḥ | śapaḥ pitā ;*
> *danudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Aśvins, the horses well yoked (सुयुक् (*suyuk*)) to the chariot carry you both (प्रति वहंति (*prati vahaṃti*)) by the chariot that is true (ऋतेन (*ṛtena*), "of the nature of truth"), that is, they bear you to come to the sacrifice. The sacrifices (मेधाः (*medhāḥ*)) turn upward (ऊर्ध्वाः (*ūrdhvāḥ*)) towards you. The illustration: पितरेव (*pitareva*), as sons go towards their parents, mother and father. Utterly destroy (वि जरेथां (*vi jarethāṃ*)) from us the Asura mind (मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*)) of the niggard (पणेः (*paṇeḥ*)). We, for our part, have made for you both (युवोः (*yuvoḥ*)) food (अवः (*avaḥ*)) in the form of oblation. Come to us, facing us.

Word-to-word meaning

- (अश्विनौ (*aśvinau*)—O Aśvins)
- सुयुक् (*suyuk*)—horses yoked to a fine chariot
- ऋतेन (*ṛtena*)—in the chariot of the nature of truth
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you both
- प्रति वहंति (*prati vahaṃti*)—bring, for coming to the sacrifice
- मेधाः (*medhāḥ*)—the sacrifices

- ऊर्ध्वाः (*ūrdhvāḥ*)—facing you
- पितरेव (*pitareva*)—as children go facing their father
- भवंति (*bhavaṃti*)—they look to you
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—from us
- पणेः मनीषां (*paṇeḥ manīṣāṃ*)—the understanding connected with the wicked
- वि जरेथां (*vi jarethāṃ*)—destroy completely
- युवोः (*yuvoḥ*)—addressing you both
- अवः (*avaḥ*)—food in the form of oblation
- चक्रम (*cakrama*)—we have prepared
- आर्वाक् (*ārvāk*)—facing us
- आ यातं (*ā yātaṃ*)—be gracious and come

Gist

O Aśvins, horses yoked to a fine chariot bring you both, in the chariot of the nature of truth, to come to the sacrifice. As children stand facing their father, the sacrifices face you. Destroy from us the understanding connected with the wicked. Addressing you both, we have prepared food in the form of oblation. Be gracious and come facing us.

English translation

The well-yoked (horses) bear you both in your truth (preserving car): the offerings proceed towards you as (children to their parents): discard from us the disposition of the niggard : we have made ready for you our offering : come to our presence.

Special Topics

In the previous mantra the relation of Uṣas to the Aśvins was stated; in the present one the prayer is that the Aśvins come towards the sacrifice. Stating the manner in which they are to come to the sacrifice, the mantra indicates the route of their coming with सुयुक् ऋतेन तां प्रतिवहंति (*suyuk ṛtena tāṃ prativahaṃti*).

Here the word ऋत (*ṛta*) has been explained as "chariot". But that is not its direct meaning: the word ऋत (*ṛta*) is first taken as "truth", and then it is explained as "of the nature of truth", with the construction with "in the chariot" or "on the chariot-way". As described in mantras such as

नृवद्दस्रा मनोयुजा रथेन पृथुपाजसा । सचेथे अश्विनोषसं ॥ (*nṛvaddasrā manoyujā rathena pṛthupājasā | sacethe aśvinoṣasaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-5-2)

the manner of coming to the sacrifice in a splendid chariot, following Uṣas as soon as she appears, is described. The word ऋत (*ṛta*) is used in the senses of truth, sacrifice, water, conduct of the nature of truth, and so on. If here it is taken as "path of the nature of truth", it may suit the context.

Even if ऋत (*ṛta*) is taken as "truth", it means that which has an eternal state. The sun and the other planets all move regularly, eternal and radiant, and (the text breaks off at the end of the window).

The path of the sun and the other planets, which move regularly and well, is permanent and radiant; it is established usage in the Ṛgveda to call this course ṛta. What the path of ṛta is, as described in the words वर्वर्ति चक्रं परि द्यामृतस्य (*varvarti cakraṃ pari dyāmṛtasya*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-11), has been explained in full earlier. This same path of ṛta is described in passages such as

अग्निर्गांधर्वीं पथ्यामृतस्याग्नेर्गव्यूतिर्घृत आ निषत्ता (*agnirgāṃdharvīṃ pathyāmṛtasyāgnergavyūtirghṛta ā niṣattā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-80-6)

as the lofty and spacious path of the Gandharva. It has likewise been explained that the path of the Ādityas and others is described by epithets such as ऋतस्य योना (*ṛtasya yonā*) and ऋतस्य पदे (*ṛtasya pade*). In the present verse the sense of ऋतेन (*ṛtena*) is that the Aśvins' excellent horses bring them along this permanent and radiant Gandharva path.

मेधाः (*medhāḥ*)—the word मेध (*medha*) means sacrifice. In some places it also means the oblation fit for the sacrifice. At मेधं जुषंत वह्नयः (*medhaṃ juṣaṃta vahnayaḥ*) (1-3-9) Sāyaṇa explains: मेध्यते देवैः सह, संगम्यते इति मेधं हविः (*medhyate devaiḥ saha, saṃgamyate iti medhaṃ* *haviḥ*) — since the oblation joins and becomes one with the gods, the word मेध (*medha*) applies to it. Or, if मेध (*medha*) is taken to mean wisdom, the act of a wise man is also मेध (*medha*). Some hold that because worship of the gods and the like is the act of the wise, the sacrifice has the name मेध (*medha*). This sense too is not without support:

यदेव विद्यया करोति श्रद्धयोपनिषदा तदेव वीर्यवत्तरं भवति (*yadeva vidyayā karoti śraddhayopaniṣadā tadeva vīryavattaraṃ bhavati*) (Bhā. U. 1-1-10)

The Chāndogya and others say that the rite performed with knowledge and with faith is the one that becomes vigorous; since the need of knowledge at the time of performing rites is thus stated, the word मेध (*medha*) may be so applicable. But in giving this sense, the etymology मेध्यते देवैः सह (*medhyate devaiḥ saha*) must still be applied to the sacrifice.

इतः प्रदानादि देवा उपजीवंति (*itaḥ pradānādi devā upajīvaṃti*) (Śa. Brā. 1-2-4-5)

The offering made from here reaches the gods, and they live because they are thereby satisfied; this shows the relation of cause and effect between the gods' existence and the sacrifice. So this etymology also fits. Or तन्नेध्यमभूत् (*tannedhyamabhūt*) (Śa. Brā. 10-6-5-7): "it became pure"; because it became pure, the word मेध (*medha*) applies — the etymology can be given thus too.

पितरेव ऊर्ध्वा भवंति (*pitareva ūrdhvā bhavaṃti*)—there is a special point in the description that the sacrifice goes to face the Aśvins and receives them, as children go to meet a father. Of the

other gods, all take part in the sacrifice, whereas the Aśvins alone have no share in it; this is known to all. The Vedic sentence अन्यत्रैवाश्विभ्यां (*anyatraivāśvibhyāṃ*) (Śa. Brā. 14-1-1-1), that Indra and the other gods took part, excluding the Aśvins, states this exactly. Yet how is a father–son relation possible? There is a story that explains the circumstance showing the close connection between the Aśvins and the sacrifice.

तावेदद्यज्ञस्य शिरः प्रत्यधत्तां तददस्तद्विवाकीर्त्यानां ब्राह्मणे व्याख्यानये यथा तद्यज्ञस्य शिरः प्रतिदधतुः तस्मात् ....॥ (*tāvedadyajñasya śiraḥ pratyadhattāṃ tadadastadvivākīrtyānāṃ brāhmaṇe vyākhyānaye yathā tadyajñasya śiraḥ pratidadhatuḥ tasmāt ....‖*) (Śa. Brā. 4-1-5-15)

In this story the Aśvins repaired the headless sacrifice so that the sacrificial work was completed; it is also said that the story is told in the Brāhmaṇa called Divākīrtya (Śa. Brā. 14-1-1-9). The same matter is recited in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa as well (Ai. Brā. 4-9). Thus, when the sacrifice lacked its principal part, they set it right and made the sacrifice indebted to them; as if to show gratitude for this, the sacrifice receives the Aśvins — so the present mantra describes.

पणिं मनीषां (*paṇiṃ manīṣāṃ*)—here पणि (*paṇi*) is taken to mean unbelievers who have no faith in the sacrifice. मनीषा (*manīṣā*) means understanding. The prayer is: may we not have such an unbelieving mind, or if we have it, destroy it and make a believing mind arise in the performance of the sacrifice.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सु॒युग्भि॒रश्वैः॑ सु॒वृता॒ रथे॑न॒ दस्रा॑वि॒मं शृ॑णुतं॒ श्लोक॒मद्रेः॑ ।
किम॒ङ्ग वां॒ प्रत्यव॑र्तिं॒ गमि॑ष्ठा॒हुर्विप्रा॑सो अश्विना पुरा॒जाः ॥ ३ ॥

> *suyugbhiraśvaiḥ suvṛtā rathena dasrāvimaṃ śṛṇutaṃ ślokamadreḥ |*
> *kimaṅga vāṃ pratyavartiṃ gamiṣṭhāhurviprāso aśvinā purājāḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सुयुक्षभिः । अश्वैः । सुवृता । रथेन । दस्रौ । इमं । शृणुतं । श्लोकं । अद्रेः ।
> किं । अंग । वां । प्रति । अवर्तिं । गमिष्ठा । आहुः । विप्रासः । अश्विना । पुराजाः ॥३॥

> *suyukṣabhiḥ | aśvaiḥ | suvṛtā | rathena | dasau | imaṃ | śṛṇutaṃ | ślokaṃ | adreḥ |*
> *kiṃ | aṃga | vāṃ | prati | avartiṃ | gamiṣṭhā | āhuḥ | viprāsaḥ | aśvinā | purājāḥ ‖3‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अश्विनौ सुयुग्भिः सुष्टु योजितैरश्वैः सुवृता । पुनःपुनरावर्तत इति
> वृच्चक्रं । शोभनचक्रोपेतेन रथेनागत्य दसौ शत्रूणामुपक्षपयितारौ युवामद्रेः । आद्रियते
> सर्वैरित्यद्रिः स्तोता । तस्येमं श्लोकं स्तोत्रं शृणुतं । अंग
> हे अश्विनौ विप्रासो मेधाविनः पुराजाः पुरातना ऋषयो वां युवामवर्ति
> मस्माकं वृत्तिहानिं प्रति गमिष्ठा अतिशयेन गंताराविति किमाहुः किं कथयंतीति ।
> न कथयंतीत्यर्थः । प्रथमाष्टकेष्टमेध्याये सुवृता रथेनेत्यादि गतं ॥
> गमिष्ठा । गंतृशब्दादिष्टनि रूपं ॥

> *he aśvinau suyugbhiḥ suṣṭu yojitairaśvaiḥ suvṛtā | punaḥpunarāvartata iti*
> *vṛccakraṃ | śobhanacakropetena rathenāgatya dasau śatrūṇāmupakṣapayitārau yuvāmadrèḥ | ādriyate sarvairityadriḥ stotā |*
> *tasyemaṃ ślokaṃ stotraṃ śṛṇutaṃ | aṃga*
> *he aśvinau viprāso medhāvinaḥ purājāḥ purātanā ṛṣayo vāṃ yuvāmavarti*
> *masmākaṃ vṛttihāniṃ prati gamiṣṭhā atiśayena gaṃtārāviti kimāhuḥ kiṃ kathayaṃtīti |*
> *na kathayaṃtītyarthaḥ | prathamāṣṭakeṣṭamedhyāye suvṛtā rathenetyādi gataṃ ‖*
> *gamiṣṭhā | gaṃtṛśabdādiṣṭani rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Aśvins, with well-yoked horses (सुयुग्भिः (*suyugbhiḥ*)) and a car (सुवृता (*suvṛtā*): वृत् (*vṛt*) is the wheel, which turns again and again — a car with fine wheels), come, दसौ (*dasau*), destroyers of enemies, and hear this praise (श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*) = स्तोत्रं (*stotraṃ*)) of the worshipper अद्रेः (*adreḥ*) — one who is honoured (आद्रियते (*ādriyate*)) by all is अद्रि (*adri*), the praiser. अंग (*aṃga*): O Aśvins, do the wise, ancient seers (विप्रासो (*viprāso*) पुराजाः (*purājāḥ*)) not say of you that you are most ready to go (गमिष्ठा (*gamiṣṭhā*)) to our अवर्तिं (*avartiṃ*), loss of livelihood? That is, they do say it. "सुवृता रथेन (*suvṛtā rathena*)" and the rest has been treated in the first Aṣṭaka, eighth Adhyāya. गमिष्ठा (*gamiṣṭhā*) is the iṣṭhan form from the word गंतृ (*gaṃtṛ*).

Word-to-word meaning

- सुयुग्भिः (*suyugbhiḥ*)—well yoked to the car
- अश्वैः (*aśvaiḥ*)—joined with horses
- सुवृता (*suvṛtā*)—having excellent wheels
- रथेन (*rathena*)—coming in the car
- दसौ (*dasau*)—you, destroyers of enemies
- अद्रेः (*adreḥ*)—of the praiser
- इमं श्लोकं (*imaṃ ślokaṃ*)—this praise
- शृणुतं (*śṛṇutaṃ*)—hear
- अंग (*aṃga*)—O Aśvins
- विप्रासः (*viprāsaḥ*)—wise
- पुराजाः (*purājāḥ*)—ancient seers
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you
- अवर्तिं प्रति (*avartiṃ prati*)—towards those afflicted by sorrow
- गमिष्ठा (*gamiṣṭhā*)—as those who go
- किं आहुः (*kiṃ āhuḥ*)—have they not said?

Gist

O Aśvins, coming in a car with excellent wheels, drawn by horses yoked in the best manner, you who destroy enemies, hear this praise of the worshipper. O Aśvins, have the wise and ancient seers not said of you that you go towards those afflicted by sorrow?

English translation

Dasras, with well-yoked horses and well-constructed car, hear this praise of the worshipper, for have not the ancient sages declared you, Ashwins, to be most ready to come to the aid of the destitute ?

Special Topics

दस्रा—दसु-उपक्षयेः-शत्रुणां उपक्षपयितारौ । यद्वा । देववैद्यतेन रोगाणां उपक्षपयितारौ । (*dasrā —dasu-upakṣayeḥ-śatruṇāṃ upakṣapayitārau | yadvā | devavaidyatena rogāṇāṃ upakṣapayitārau* |) It means destroyers of enemies, or, being divine physicians, destroyers of diseases. दस्रा (*dasrā*) may also mean दर्शनीयौ (*darśanīyau*), those of beautiful form. In the present verse the commentator takes it as destroyers of enemies. Of the Aśvins, sons of Saraṇyū, one is named Dasra and the other Nāsatya, yet it is customary to speak of both together as दस्रा (*dasrā*).

अद्रेः (*adreḥ*)—the word अद्रि (*adri*) is used in the senses of the soma-pressing stone, mountain and so on, and its special senses have been given earlier. Here it is taken to mean the praiser. आद्रियते सर्वैरित्यद्रि (*ādriyate sarvairityadri*): because he is honoured by all, the praiser is designated by the epithet अद्रि (*adri*); this is understood from Sāyaṇa's explanation.

सुवृता (*suvṛtā*)—पुनःपुनरावर्तत इति वृत् चक्रं (*punaḥpunarāvartata iti vṛt cakraṃ*): since the wheel turns repeatedly, the word वृत् (*vṛt*) is used for it. The qualified word सुवृता (*suvṛtā*) shows an excellent wheel. The epithets त्रिवंधुरः (*trivaṃdhuraḥ*) and त्रिचक्रः (*tricakraḥ*) of the Aśvins' car and their distinction have been given earlier.

श्लोकं (*ślokaṃ*)—स्तुतिं (*stutiṃ*): here it is explained as praise. In the Saṃhitā the meaning of this word has to be stated according to context. Where the word is used in Brāhmaṇa sentences, the sense given is, as is current here, a metrically bound composition. But in the Ṛgveda there is no rule that it must be taken as such a composition. For instance:

यदद्रयः पर्वताः साकमाशवः श्लोकं घोषं भरथेंद्राय सोमिनः॥ (*yadadrayaḥ parvatāḥ sākamāśavaḥ ślokaṃ ghoṣaṃ bharatheṃdrāya sominaḥ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94-1)

In this verse the nature of the sound made by the stones at the time of soma-pressing is described. Here the word घोष (*ghoṣa*) has the epithet श्लोक (*śloka*): श्लोकं श्रोतव्यं घोषं (*ślokaṃ śrotavyaṃ ghoṣaṃ*) — an audible sound, that is, a sound pleasing to hear. Similarly,

युजे नां ब्रह्म पूर्व्यं नमोभिर्वि श्लोक एतु पथ्येव सूरेः । (*yuje nāṃ brahma pūrvyaṃ namobhirvi śloka etu pathyeva sūreḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-13-1)

here the carts that hold the oblation are described; the prayer is that their श्लोक (*śloka*), their sound, go to the gods from all sides and satisfy them. Thus, though in some places the word is used in the sense of sound, in many contexts the sense of praise is well established. On this basis the English commentators have taken the word as "noise" even in the Śatapatha and elsewhere. For example:

श्लोकाय स्वाहेति वीर्यं वै श्लोको विरेणैवेनं....। (*ślokāya svāheti vīryaṃ vai śloko vireṇaivainaṃ....|*) (Śa. Brā. 5-3-5-9)

They render it: "To the noise, hail. " noise means vigour ; with vigour he thus sprinkles him. According to this explanation श्लोक (*śloka*) means vigorous sound. But in explaining the sense of Brāhmaṇa sentences, Sāyaṇa and others have given it as a composition in verse-quarters (पाद (*pāda*)).

For example, in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, at तदप्येषश्लोकोऽभिगीतः (*tadapyeṣaśloko 'bhigītaḥ*) — "on this matter this śloka is recited" — Sāyaṇa explains श्लोकः पादबद्धः मंत्रः (*ślokaḥ pādabaddhaḥ maṃtraḥ*), a mantra bound in verse-quarters. This śloka stands bound in quarters in the form मरुतः परिवेष्टारः मरुतस्यावसन् गृहे (*marutaḥ pariveṣṭāraḥ marutasyāvasan gṛhe*) and so on. But though the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa has the quarter-bound order, the same sentence in the Śatapatha (Śa. Brā. 13-5-4-6) is not subject to this rule. This rule can be seen in the Upaniṣads and the like.

यजुर्वेदः सामवेदोऽथर्वांगिरस इतिहासः पुराणं विद्या उपनिषदः श्लोकाः (*yajurvedaḥ sāmavedo 'tharvāṃgirasa itihāsaḥ purāṇaṃ vidyā upaniṣadaḥ ślokāḥ*) (Bṛ. U. 2-4-10)

Here the श्लोक (*śloka*) is said to be distinct from the four Vedas, the Upaniṣads, Itihāsa and Purāṇa. श्लोका ब्राह्मणप्रभवा मंत्राः तदेते श्लोकाः (*ślokā brāhmaṇaprabhavā maṃtrāḥ tadete ślokāḥ*)—Śaṅkarācārya explains in his commentary that श्लोक (*śloka*) means the mantras cited in the Brāhmaṇas. Examples can be seen in many places.

स्वप्नेन शारीरमभिप्रहत्यासुप्तः सुप्तानभिचाकशीति । शुक्रमादाय पुनरैति स्थानं हिरण्मयः पुरुष एकहंसः ॥ (*svapnena śārīramabhiprahatyāsuptaḥ suptānabhicākaśīti | śukramādāya punaraiti sthānaṃ hiraṇmayaḥ puruṣa ekahaṃsaḥ ||*)

These and the like are specimens of श्लोक (*śloka*) in the Chāndogya and other Upaniṣads. Further, the Taittirīya Upaniṣad uses this word in two senses.

इदं पुच्छं प्रतिष्ठा । तदप्येष श्लोको भवति (*idaṃ pucchaṃ pratiṣṭhā | tadapyeṣa śloko bhavati*) (Tai. U. 2-1)

Here श्लोक (*śloka*) means a mantra. Having first stated the greatness of some principle, another mantra is cited to support it; in such a context it is the practice in the Upaniṣads and the like to say तदप्येष श्लोको भवति (*tadapyeṣa śloko bhavati*). Besides,

अहमन्न महमन्न महमन्नं । अहमन्नादोऽ २ हमन्नादोऽ २ हमन्नादः । अहग् श्लोकतृदहग् श्लोककृदहग् श्लोककृत् ॥ (*ahamanna mahamanna mahamannaṃ | ahamannādos 2 hamannādos 2 hamannādaḥ | ahag ślokatṛdahag ślokakṛdahag ślokakṛt ‖*) (Tai. U. 3-10)

"I am food; I am the eater of food; I am the combination of food and eater of food" — here श्लोक (*śloka*) is taken to mean combination. श्लोको नाम अन्नान्नादयोः संघातः (*śloko nāma annānnādayoḥ saṃghātaḥ*): Śaṅkarācārya explains that श्लोक (*śloka*) means the combined form of food and the eater of food. The sense current here is also derived from this same root. श्लोक (*śloka*)

is derived from the root श्लोक् (*ślok*), meaning combination (संघाते (*saṃghāte*)). To string pleasing words together in metre means to bring words together according to rule, in the way of the grammarians. Śaṅkarācārya gives this same meaning for the word in the cited Upaniṣad sentence. It is the context in which the Self describes its own Brahman nature: "the aggregate of food and the eater of food is also I."

Since such usages exist, in the present verse श्लोक (*śloka*) is taken as praise. It may be a combination of mantras praising the gods, or, as Sāyaṇa says in explaining the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa sentence, a praise bound in quarters, of the nature of a mantra and a combination of words.

अंग (*aṃga*) is an address to the Aśvins; it may mean "those with attractive limbs". Epithets such as युवाना (*yuvānā*), वल्गू (*valgū*), मधुवर्णा (*madhuvarṇā*), शुभस्पती (*śubhaspatī*) describe the attractive limbs of the Aśvins.

पुराजाः नां आहुः (*purājāḥ nāṃ āhuḥ*)[?185]—the sentence "the ancient seers have said that you go towards those afflicted by sorrow" points to occasions when many seers in the past praised the Aśvins' generosity and power. It is well known that Kutsa Āṅgirasa and others praised them, describing how the Aśvins protected sufferers such as Rebha and Vandana, in sentences like याभी रेभं निवृतं सितं (*yābhī rebhaṃ nivṛtaṃ sitaṃ*). The same point is stated here.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ म॑न्येथा॒मा ग॑तं॒ कच्चि॒देवै॒र्विश्वे॒ जना॑सो अ॒श्विना॑ हवन्ते ।
इ॒मा हि वां॒ गोऋ॑जीका॒ मधू॑नि॒ प्र मि॒त्रासो॒ न द॒दुरु॒स्रो अग्रे॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *ā manyethāmā gataṃ kaccidevairviśve janāso aśvinā havante |*
> *imā hi vāṃ gorjīkā madhūni pra mitrāso na dadurusro agre ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । मन्येथां । आ । गतं । कत् । चित् । एवैः । विश्वे । जनासः । अश्विना । हवंते ।
> इमा । हि । वां । गोऋजीका । मधूनि । प्र । मित्रासः । न । ददुः । उस्रः । अग्रे ॥

> *ā | manyethāṃ | ā | gataṃ | kat | cit | evaiḥ | viśve | janāsaḥ | aśvinā | havaṃte |*
> *imā | hi | vāṃ | gorjīkā | madhūni | pra | mitrāsaḥ | na | daduḥ | usraḥ | agre ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> क्वचिदिति प्रश्नॆ । हे अश्विनौ आ मन्येथां । इमां मदीयां स्तुतिं जानीतं ।
> किंच एवैर्गमनसाधनैरश्वैरा गतं । यज्ञं प्रत्यागच्छतं । विश्वे सर्वॆ जनासः
> स्तोतारोऽश्विनाश्विन् वां युवां हवंते । स्तुतिलक्षणाभिर्वाग्भिराह्वयंति । किंच
> गोऋजीका गवां पयसा मिश्रणोपेतानि मधूनि मदकराणि सोमरसरूपाणीमेमानि हवींषि
> युवाभ्यां प्र ददुः । अध्वर्यादयः प्रयच्छंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः ।
> मित्रासो न । यथा मित्राणि मित्रेभ्योऽपेक्षितं ददति तद्वत् । उस्रः । वसति नभसीत्युस्रः सूरः
> । अग्र उषसोऽग्र उदेति । तस्मादागच्छतमिति भावः ॥ ददुः । दाण्
> दान इत्यस्य लिट्युसि रूपं । हियोगादनिघातः । उस्रः । वस निवासे । स्थायितंबीत्यादिना
> रक् । कित्वात्संप्रसारणं । शासिवसिघसीनां चेति षत्वाभावश्छांदसः ॥

> *kvaciditi praśnè | he aśvinau ā manyethāṃ | imāṃ madīyāṃ stutiṃ jānītaṃ |*
> *kiṃca evairgamanasādhanairaśvairā gataṃ | yajñaṃ pratyāgacchataṃ | viśve sarvè janāsaḥ*
> *stotāro 'śvināśvin vāṃ yuvāṃ havaṃte |*
> *stutilakṣaṇābhirvāgnirāhvayaṃti | kiṃca*
> *goṛjīkā gavāṃ payasā miśraṇopetāni madhūni madakarāṇi*
> *somarasarūpāṇīmemāni havīṃṣi yuvābhyāṃ pra daduḥ |*
> *adhvaryādayaḥ prayacchaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *mitrāso na | yathā mitrāṇi mitrebhyo 'pekṣitaṃ dadati tadvat | usraḥ |*
> *vasati nabhasītyusraḥ sūraḥ | agra uṣaso 'gra udeti |*
> *tasmādāgacchatamiti bhāvaḥ ‖ daduḥ | dāṇ*
> *dāna ityasya liṭyusi rūpaṃ | hiyogādanighātaḥ | usraḥ | vasa nivāse |*
> *sthāyitaṃbītyādinā rak | kitvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | śāsivasighasīnāṃ ceti*
> *ṣatvābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa takes कच्चित् (*kaccit*) as marking a question. "O Aśvins, आ मन्येथां (*ā manyethāṃ*): know this praise of mine." He adds: "come also with एवैः (*evaiḥ*), that is, with horses, the means of travel; come to the sacrifice." विश्वे जनासः (*viśve janāsaḥ*) are all the singers, who call you, Aśvins, with praises. Further, गोऋजीका (*goṛjīkā*) means "mixed with the milk of cows." मधूनि (*madhūni*) means "intoxicating," that is, these oblations in the form of Soma juice. The Adhvaryu and the others offer (प्र ददुः (*pra daduḥ*)) them to you. The simile is मित्रासो न (*mitrāso* *na*): as friends give their friends what they need. उस्रः (*usraḥ*) is the sun, who dwells in the sky. He rises ahead of the dawn. The sense is therefore: "come."

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Word-to-word meaning

- कच्चित् आ मन्येथाः (*kaccit ā manyethāḥ*)—if you regard our praise as good
- एवैः (*evaiḥ*)—with horses, the means of travel
- आ गतं (*ā gataṃ*)—come to our sacrifice
- विश्वे जनासः (*viśve janāsaḥ*)—all the singers too
- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—O Aśvin deities
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you
- हवंते (*havaṃte*)—call, praying
- गोऋजीका (*goṛjīkā*)—mixed with milk
- मधूनि (*madhūni*)—sweet, in the form of Soma juice
- इमा (*imā*)—these oblations
- मित्रासो न (*mitrāso na*)—as one gives lovingly to friends
- प्र ददुः (*pra daduḥ*)—offer to you
- उस्रः (*usraḥ*)—the sun
- अग्रे (*agre*)—has risen in front

Gist

O Aśvin deities, if you regard our praise as good, come to our sacrifice with horses, the means of travel. All the singers too call you with prayer. They offer to you these oblations, mixed with milk and sweet, in the form of Soma juice, as one gives lovingly to friends. The sun has risen in front. Therefore be gracious to this sacrifice.

English translation

If you regard (my prayer), come with your quick steeds : all men, Ashwins, invoke you : to you they offer the sweet (Soma) juice mixed with milk, as friends (give gifts to friends) : the sun is in advance, (therefore come to the rite).

Special Topics

एवैः (*evaiḥ*)—गमनसाधनैः (*gamanasādhanaiḥ*): "with horses that help in moving about." Ordinarily this epithet denotes the Maruts, the companions of Indra. Words such as एवासः (*evāsaḥ*) and एवयामरुत् (*evayāmarut*) describe the Maruts. But in a few places it is used as an epithet of horses, the means of travel. Moreover, in

सनाद्दिवं परि भूमा विरूपे पुनर्भुवा युवती स्वेभिरेवैः । (*sanāddivaṃ pari bhūmā virūpe punarbhuvā yuvatī svebhirevaiḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-62-8),

in the description that Night and Dawn move alternately by their own attractive, revolving comings and goings, the word means simply "going." Where the word is an epithet of the Maruts, its special sense has been explained earlier.

उस्रः (*usraḥ*)—वसति नभसीत्युस्रः सूर्यः (*vasati nabhasītyusraḥ sūryaḥ*): it is explained that the sun is named Usra because he dwells in the sky. In general it is hard to give a definite meaning for the words उस्रः (*usraḥ*), उस्रा (*usrā*), उस्रिया (*usriyā*) and उस्रिक (*usrika*); one must state it according to each context. In

द्रन्नो वन्वन् क्रत्वा नार्वोस्रः पितेव जारयायि यज्ञैः । (*dranno vanvan kratvā nārvosraḥ piteva jārayāyi yajñaiḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-12-4)

the word usra is used as a synonym of "bull." Usra can also mean a sun-ray. The words उस्रा (*usrā*) and उस्प्रिया (*uspriyā*) also occur as synonyms of "milk."

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ति॒रः पु॒रू चि॑दश्विना॒ रजां॑स्याङ्गू॒षो वां॑ मघवाना॒ जने॑षु ।
एह या॑तं प॒थिभि॑र्दे॒वया॒नै॑र्दस्रा॑वि॒मे वां॑ नि॒धयो॒ मधू॑नाम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *tiraḥ purū cidaśvinā rajāṃsyāṅgūṣo vāṃ maghavānā janeṣu |*
> *eha yātaṃ pathibhirdevayānairdasrāvime vāṃ nidhayo madhūnām ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तिरः । पुरु । चित् । अश्विना । रजांसि । आंगूषः । वां । मघवाना । जनेषु ।

> *tiraḥ | puru | cit | aśvinā | rajāṃsi | āṃgūṣaḥ | vāṃ | maghavānā | janeṣu |*

> आ । इह । यातं । पथिभिः । देवयानैः । दसौ । इमे । वां । निधयः ।
> मधूनां ॥ ५ ॥

> *ā | iha | yātaṃ | pathibhiḥ | devayānaiḥ | dasau | ime | vāṃ | nidhayaḥ |*
> *madhūnāṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे आश्विनौ पुरू चिद्बहून्यपि रजांसि स्थानानि तिरः स्वतेजसा तिरस्कुर्वंत् वां
> युवामिह कर्मणि देवयानैः पथिभिर्मार्गैरा यातं । मघवाना धनवंत् हे
> आश्विनौ जनेषु स्तोतृषु वां युवयोरांगूष आ समंताद्घोषणीयं स्तोत्रं
> वर्तते । दसौ शत्रूणामुपक्षपयितारौ हे आश्विनौ वां युवयोर्मधूनां मदकराणां सोमानामिमे
> निधयः । निधीयतेऽत्र सोम इति निधयः पात्रविशेषाः ।
> संति । तस्मादागच्छतमिति भावः ॥ अंगूषः । अज्वावार्द्युषेः कर्मणि घञ् । आघुष्यत
> इत्याघोषः । घो इत्यस्य पृषोदरादित्वादू इत्यादेशः ।
> आजोऽनुनासिकश्चंदसीत्यनच्यप्यनुनासिकश्कांदसः । यद्वा । आगिर्गत्यर्थः । आस्मादंगूष
> इति सूत्रेणोषच् प्रत्ययांतो निपातितः । अंगति गच्छति देवानित्यंगूषः स्तोत्रं । अंगूष
> एवांगूषः । प्रज्ञादित्वात्स्वार्थिकोऽण् । प्रत्येयस्वरः । एह यातमित्यर्धर्चोगतः॥

> *he āśvinau purū cidbhahūnyapi rajāṃsi sthānāni tiraḥ svatejasā tiraskurvaṃt vāṃ*
> *yuvāmiha karmaṇi devayānaiḥ pathibhirmārgairā yātaṃ | maghavānā dhanavaṃt he*
> *āśvinau janeṣu stotṛṣu vāṃ yuvayorāṃgūṣa ā samaṃtāddoṣaṇīyaṃ stotraṃ*
> *vartate | dasau śatrūṇāmupakṣapayitārau he āśvinau vāṃ*
> *yuvayormadhūnāṃ madakarāṇāṃ somānāmime nidhayaḥ | nidhīyate 'tra soma iti nidhayaḥ pātraviśeṣāḥ |*
> *saṃti | tasmādāgacchatamiti bhāvaḥ ‖ aṃgūṣaḥ | ajvārvādyuṣeḥ*

> *karmaṇi ghañ | āghuṣyata ityāghoṣaḥ | gho ityasya pṛṣodarāditvādū ityādeśaḥ | ājo 'nunāsikaścaṃdasītyanacyapyanunāsikaśkāṃdasaḥ | yadvā | āgirgatyarthaḥ | āsmādaṃgūṣa iti sūtreṇoṣac pratyayāṃto nipātitaḥ | aṃgati gacchati devānityaṃgūṣaḥ stotraṃ | aṃgūṣa evāṃgūṣaḥ | prajñāditvātsvārthiko 'ṇ | pratyèyasvaraḥ | eha yātamityardharcogataḥ‖*

Summary

"O Aśvins, eclipsing (तिरः (*tiraḥ*)) by your own splendour many (पुरू चित् (*purū cit*)) realms, that is, places, come here to this rite by the paths (पथिभिः (*pathibhiḥ*)) on which the gods travel. O opulent ones (मघवाना (*maghavānā*)), among the people, that is, among the singers, there is a praise (आंगूषः (*āṃgūṣaḥ*)) of you, to be recited all round. O Dasras, removers of enemies, these निधयः (*nidhayaḥ*) of yours are filled with intoxicating Soma." The निधयः (*nidhayaḥ*) are special vessels, so called because the Soma is deposited in them. Hence the sense: "come." Sāyaṇa derives अंगूषः (*aṃgūṣaḥ*) in two ways. By the second, the praise is so called because it goes (अंगति (*aṃgati*)) to the gods. He closes by saying that the half-verse एह यातं (*eha yātaṃ*) is complete.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरू चित् (*purū cit*)—many
- रजांसि (*rajāṃsi*)—worlds
- तिरः (*tiraḥ*)—you who pervade with your splendour
- इह (*iha*)—to be in this rite
- देवयानैः (*devayānaiḥ*)—on which the gods travel
- पथिभिः (*pathibhiḥ*)—by paths
- आ यातं (*ā yātaṃ*)—come
- मेघवाना (*mèghavānā*)—O wealthy Aśvin deities
- जनेषु (*janeṣu*)—among the singers
- वां (*vāṃ*)—on your behalf
- अंगूषः (*aṃgūṣaḥ*)—the singer (is abundant)
- दसौ (*dasau*)—O Aśvin deities, destroyers of enemies
- वां (*vāṃ*)—meant for you
- मधूनां (*madhūnāṃ*)—filled with Soma

- इमे निधयः (*ime nidhayaḥ*)—these vessels are ready

Gist

O Aśvin deities, you who pervade even many worlds with your splendour, come by the paths on which the gods travel, to take part in this rite. O wealthy Aśvins, among the singers the praise on your behalf is abundant. O Aśvins, destroyers of enemies, these vessels, meant for you and filled with Soma, are ready.

English translation

Eclipsing (by your splendour) many regions, Ashwins, (come hither); loud praise awaits you opulent (Ashwins) amongst men : come to this rite by the paths traversed by. the gods: here, Dasras, are ample stores of the exhilarating juices

Special Topics

The pervasive power of the Aśvins' splendour and the nature of the path on which they travel are described in this Ṛk. The nature of that path is described by देवयानैः पथिभिः (*devayānaiḥ pathibhiḥ*).

देवयानैः पथिभिः (*devayānaiḥ pathibhiḥ*)—The natures of the two paths, devayāna and pitṛyāna, were briefly explained earlier (Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, Part 12, pp. 563-564). But since the two courses of the individual soul, bound to its actions, were there indicated only briefly and as the context required, some points not explained there are given here. The path by which gods travel from heaven to earth and from earth to heaven has been called devayāna from the time of the Vedic Saṃhitās. In the Brāhmaṇas and other Śruti and Smṛti texts, and in the works of the ancient and later poets who illumined secular literature, this word has a technical meaning. In the beginning, however, its real nature was not described so precisely, and only a gross picture was suggested by the technical word itself. In some Smṛti and other works this word is a synonym for the chariot, the vehicle of the gods. But this meaning is very secondary and does not show the established sense. That devayāna and pitṛyāna are, from the spiritual point of view, the higher and the lower path is a matter that can be learned exactly from the

Upaniṣads and the like. It also suggests the belief that the soul which travels by devayāna to the excellent world of the Ādityas receives the full help of the gods. By descriptions such as परं मृत्यो अनु परे हि पंथां (*paraṃ mṛtyo anu pare hi paṃthāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-18-1), it is said to be a path free from death.

In the Ṛk Saṃhitā this path is described as connected with Agni, who creates the relation between gods and men. It is an established matter that he carries the sacrificial oblation to the gods and offers it, and also brings the gods themselves to the place of sacrifice and honours them. But for these tasks there is a definite path, and it is known to Agni alone.

अस्मे वत्सं परि षंतं न विंदन्निच्छंतो विश्वे अमृता अमूराः । श्रमयुवः पदव्यो धियंधास्तस्थुः पदे परमे चार्वग्नेः । (*asme vatsaṃ pari ṣaṃtaṃ na viṃdannicchaṃto viśve amṛtā amūrāḥ | śramayuvaḥ padavyo dhiyaṃdhāstasthuḥ pade parame cārvagneḥ |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-2-2)

"O Agni, you know the path on which the gods travel, and you are their messenger. To carry their oblation, the gods and the others, desiring your help, knew the highest place in which you are and the path to your world; yet they did not see you alone, and they stood in your world."

In the beginning, the path on which Agni, carrying the oblation, travels became known in the end as the path on which the sacrificer, the performer of the sacrifice, also travels.

स एष देवयानो वा पितृयाणो वा पंथाः । तदुभयतोऽग्निशिखे समोषंत्यौ तिष्ठतः प्रति तमोषतो यः प्रत्युष्योऽत्युतगं् सृजेते योऽतिसृज्यः शांतिरापस्तदेतमवैतत्पंथानगं् शमयति ॥ (*sa eṣa devayāno vā pitṛyāṇo vā paṃthāḥ | tadubhayato 'gniśikhe samoṣaṃtyau tiṣṭhataḥ prati tamoṣato yaḥ pratyuṣyo 'tyutagṃ sṛjete yo 'tisṛjyaḥ śāṃtirāpastadetamavaitatpaṃthānagṃ śamayati ||*)

(Śa. Brā. 1-9-3-2)

The path that carries either to the world of the gods or to the world of the fathers is one. On both sides of this common path two flames burn steadily. They do not harm the doer of good but make room for his passage; the doer of evil they burn. Therefore

यत्रासते सुकृतो यत्र ते ययुस्तत्र त्वा देवःस विता दधातु (*yatrāsate sukṛto yatra te yayustatra tvā devaḥsa vitā dadhātu*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 18-17-4).

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Since Savitṛ is the god who leads the doers of good on the good path, he is prayed to lead the sacrificers, the doers of good, on that same pure path, free from dust and free from death.

Thus one description is that a single path leads to both the world of the gods and the world of the fathers, and that the easy way on it accords with each person's actions. Another kind is the description in which the two paths are given separately: one the path of the doers of good, the other the path of those without that. But there is one main point to be noticed here: in the Ṛk Saṃhitā passage सुकृतो यत्र ते (*sukṛto yatra te*) good action is praised. What is that good action? Is it only the performance of sacrifice, or is there something else? The answer is: if a man is without knowledge and merely a performer of sacrifice, he has no entry to devayāna; the man of knowledge has entry. But the rule that he must also be a performer of sacrifice is not clearly stated. Then who has the right to enter devayāna? For now, the question of that right and its answer are not relevant to us. Who is such a person, and what the nature of his action should be, will be explained later as the context permits. In the present context only the description of the path is relevant. So one must understand what is the nature of the path on which the gods travel or which the doer of good follows, and what is the nature of the path on which the one without it travels. One must also understand whether the devayāna on which the Aśvins are to travel in this Ṛk is described in the Upaniṣads and the like just as it is in the Ṛk Saṃhitā and the like.

Earlier, when explaining the path of Ṛta, the nature of the paths well known in the Ṛk Saṃhitā, the path of the Ādityas, the path of the Gandharvas and the path of the gods, was explained with examples. That is described as an eternal and steady path. Although some points show that the account of the path in the Upaniṣads and the like differs from it in many ways, it can be said that the reality described in both settings is the same. This path of the gods is described thus in the Chāndogya Upaniṣad:

ये चेमेऽरण्ये श्रद्धा तप इत्युपासते तेऽर्चिषमभिसंभवंत्यर्चिषाहरह्न आपूर्यमाणपक्षमापूर्यमाणपक्षाद्यान्नड्डुदजेति मासांस्तान् । मासेभ्यः संवत्सरं संवत्सरादादित्यमादित्याच्चंद्रमसं चंद्रमसो विद्युतं तत्पुरुषोऽमानवः स एनान्ब्रह्म गमयत्येष देवयानः पंथा इति ॥ (*ye ceme 'raṇye śraddhā tapa ityupāsate te 'rciṣamabhisaṃbhavaṃtyarciṣāharahna āpūryamāṇapakṣamāpūryamāṇapakṣādyānnaḍudajeti māsāṃstān | māsebhyaḥ saṃvatsaraṃ saṃvatsarādādityamādityāccaṃdramasaṃ caṃdramaso vidyutaṃ tatpuruṣo 'mānavaḥ sa enānbrahma gamayatyeṣa devayānaḥ paṃthā iti ‖*)

(Bhā. U. 5-10-1, 2)

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Those who, knowing the fire-knowledge, practise austerity joined with faith enter the flame. (This is the sun's ray in the form of fire, in the flame of the funeral pyre.) From this flame, which is of the nature of light, they enter the day; from the day, the bright fortnight; from the bright fortnight, the uttarāyaṇa, the northern course of the sun; from there, the year; from the year, the world of the Ādityas; from there, the moon-world, other than it; from there, the world of lightning. This is devayāna.

अथ य इमे ग्राम इष्टापूर्ते दत्तमित्युपासते ते धूममभिसंभवंति धूमाद्रात्रिं रात्रेरपरपक्षमपरपक्षाद्यान्नड्डक्षिणैतिमासांस्तान्नैते संवत्सरमभिप्राप्नुवंति मासेभ्यः पितृलोकं पितृलोकादाकाशं .... तं देवा भक्षयंति । (*atha ya ime grāma iṣṭāpūrte dattamityupāsate te dhūmamabhisaṃbhavaṃti dhūmādrātriṃ rātreraparapakṣamaparapakṣādyānnaḍḍakṣiṇaitimāsāṃstānnaite saṃvatsaramabhiprāpruvaṃti māsebhyaḥ pitṛlokaṃ pitṛlokādākāśaṃ .... taṃ devā bhakṣayaṃti |*)

(Bhā. U. 5-10-3, 4)

Those who live in villages and, placing faith in sacrificial action done for desire, perform the action, enter the smoke. From the smoke they enter the night, full of darkness; from the night, the dark fortnight; from the dark fortnight, the dakṣiṇāyana; from the dakṣiṇāyana, the year; from there, the world of the fathers; from there, the sky; and through it, the world of the Moon (Soma). Since Soma is food for the gods, they eat it. The same description, slightly varied, is given in the same way in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad also (6-2-15). In the account of pitṛyāna the sky is not included. Moreover,

अणुः पंथा विततः पुराणो मां स्पषोऽनुवित्तो मय्येव । तेन धीरा अपियंति ब्रह्मविदः स्वर्ग० लोकमित ऊर्ध्वं विमुक्ताः ॥ (*aṇuḥ paṃthā vitataḥ purāṇo māṃ spaṣo 'nuvitto mayyeva | tena dhīrā apiyaṃti brahmavidaḥ svargao lokamita ūrdhvaṃ vimuktāḥ ‖*)

(Bṛ. U. 4-4-8)

This subtle path is eternal and ancient. By this path the knowers of the Veda, becoming liberated, enter the world of heaven. And further,

तस्मिञ्चुक्लमुत नीलमाहुः पिंगलं हरितं लोहितं च । एष पंथा ब्रह्मणा हानुवित्तस्तेनैति ब्रह्मवित्पुण्यकृत्यैजसश्च ॥ (*tasmiñcuklamuta nīlamāhuḥ piṃgalaṃ haritaṃ lohitaṃ ca | eṣa paṃthā brahmaṇā hānuvittastenaiti brahmavitpuṇyakṛtyaijasaśca ‖*)
(Bṛ. U. 4-4-9)

This path is famed for a mixture of colours and is highly attractive. White, blue, tawny, green and red all combine to make a delightful path. The description of its nature says that the knower of Brahman and the one who does meritorious deeds travel by this radiant path alone.

Another point must be noted in this context. Earlier, in explaining the phrase तिस्रो महीरुपरास्तस्थुः (*tisro mahīruparāstasthuḥ*) in the second Ṛk of Sūkta 56 of this same chapter, it was explained that the Saṃhitā passages themselves make known that there is no world other than the world of Āditya, which is the highest and best of the worlds. But in the Chāndogya, here cited, the description runs: the world of

Āditya, beyond it the world of the Moon, and beyond that the world of lightning. The Kauṣītaki Upaniṣad has one more distinctive feature:

स एवं देवयानं पंथानमापद्याग्निलोकमागच्छति स वायुलोकं स आदित्यलोकं स वरुणलोकं स इंद्रलोकं स प्रजापतिलोकं स ब्रह्मलोकं ॥ (*sa evaṃ devayānaṃ paṃthānamāpadyāgnilokamāgacchati sa vāyulokaṃ sa ādityalokaṃ sa varuṇalokaṃ sa iṃdralokaṃ sa prajāpatilokaṃ sa brahmalokaṃ ‖*) (Kauṣītaki Upaniṣad 1-3)

The doer of good, having thus entered the path of the gods, comes from there in order to the world of Vāyu, then the world of Āditya, the world of Varuṇa, the world of Indra, the world of Prajāpati, and finally the world of Brahman; so he reaches the world of Brahman, the supreme principle. No scriptural basis can be named for this kind of division. There are many differing points between it and the description of the worlds in the Ṛk Saṃhitā.

सूर्यद्वारेण ते विरजाः प्रयांति यत्रामृतः स पुरुषो ह्यव्ययात्मा । (*sūryadvāreṇa te virajāḥ prayāṃti yatrāmṛtaḥ sa puruṣo hyavyayātmā |*) (Mu. U. 1-1)

This description of the door of the sun agrees with the description of the Ṛk Saṃhitā. The path called the Gandharva path, spoken of in the Ṛk अग्निर्गांधर्विं पथ्यां (*agnirgāṃdharviṃ pathyāṃ*) (10-80-6), is to be understood here as the path of the gods, the Devayāna, on which the Aśvins travel. Among the worlds indicated in the present Ṛk, this path of the Devayāna is only one part. Therefore

the other, still more extensive worlds are also indicated by पुरू चित् रजांसि (*purū cit rajāṃsi*). What the nature of those worlds may be according to the Ṛk Saṃhitā has been stated earlier.

रजांसि (*rajāṃsi*)—Uses of this word in many senses, such as the delightful heaven, light, water and the atmosphere, were stated earlier (Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, part 2, pp. 57-59).

आंगूषः (*āṃgūṣaḥ*)—आंगूषस्तोम आघोषः (*āṃgūṣastoma āghoṣaḥ*) (Ni. 5-11): a hymn to be recited aloud is called āṅgūṣa.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

पु॒रा॒णमोक॑ः स॒ख्यं शि॒वं वां॑ यु॒वोर्न॑रा॒ द्रवि॑णं ज॒ह्नाव्या॑म् ।
पुन॑ः कृण्वा॒नाः स॒ख्या शि॒वानि॒ मध्वा॑ मदेम स॒ह नू स॑मा॒नाः ॥ ६ ॥

> *purāṇamokaḥ sakhyaṃ śivaṃ vāṃ yuvornarā draviṇaṃ jahnāvyām |*
> *punaḥ kṛṇvānāḥ sakhyā śivāni madhvā madema saha nū samānāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> पुराणं । ओकः । सख्यं । शिवं । वां । युवोः । नरा । द्रविणं । जह्नाव्यां ।
> पुनरिति । कृण्वानाः । सख्या । शिवानि । मध्वा । मदेम । सह । नु । समानाः ॥ ६ ॥

> *purāṇam | okaḥ | sakhyam | śivam | vām | yuvoḥ | narā | draviṇam | jahnāvyām |*
> *punariti | kṛṇvānāḥ | sakhyā | śivāni | madhvā | madema | saha | nu | samānāḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अप्तोर्यामितिरिक्तोर्थ्येच्छावाकशस्त्रे पुराणमोक इति चतस्रो
> विकल्पेन याज्याः । सूत्रितं च । यदि नाधीयात्पुराणमोकः सख्यं शिवं वामिति
> चतस्रो याज्याः ! आ. ९–११ । इति ॥
> हे अश्विनौ वां युवयोः पुराणं पुरातनं सख्यमोकः सेव्यं शिवं कल्याणकरं भवति । किंच हे
> नरा नरावस्मदीय कर्मणो नेतारौ युवोर्युवयोर्द्रविणं धनं जह्नाव्यां जह्नु कुलजायां भवति।
> शिवानि सुखकराणि युवयोः सख्यानि
> पुनः कृण्वानाः कुर्वंतः समाना हविष्प्रदानेनोपकारकत्वान्मित्रभूता एकीभूताः
> संतो वयं मध्वा मदकरेण सोमेन युवां सह युगपत् नु क्षिप्रं मदेम ।
> हर्षयेम ॥ सख्यं । सख्युर्भाव इत्यर्थे सख्युर्य इति यत्पत्ययः । जह्नाव्यां ।

> *aptoryāmetiriktorthyecchāvākaśastre purāṇamoka iti catasro*
> *vikalpena yājyāḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | yadi nādhīyātpurāṇamokaḥ sakhyaṃ śivaṃ vāmiti*

> *catasro yājyāḥ ! ā. 9-11 | iti ‖*
> *he aśvinau vāṃ yuvayoḥ purāṇaṃ purātanaṃ sakhyamokaḥ sevyaṃ śivaṃ kalyāṇakaraṃ bhavati | kiṃca he narā narāvasmadīya karmaṇo netārau yuvoryuvayordraviṇaṃ dhanaṃ jahnāvyāṃ jahnu kulajāyāṃ bhavati| śivāni sukhakarāṇi yuvayoḥ sakhyāni*
> *punaḥ kṛṇvānāḥ kurvaṃtaḥ samānā haviṣpradānenopakārakatvānmitrabhūtā ekībhūtāḥ*
> *saṃto vayaṃ madhvā madakareṇa somena yuvāṃ saha yugapat nu kṣipraṃ madema |*
> *harṣayema ‖ sakhyaṃ | sakhyurbhāva ityarthe sakhyurya iti yatpatyayaḥ | jahnāvyāṃ |*

> जह्नोः संबंधिनीत्यर्थे तस्येदमित्यण् । ओर्गुणः । ह्रस्वदीर्घयोर्व्यत्ययः ।
> मदेनु । मदी हर्ष इत्यस्याशीर्लिज् लिज्याशिष्यज् प्रत्ययः । निघातः ॥

> *jahnoḥ saṃbaṃdhinītyarthe tasyedamityaṇ | orguṇaḥ |*
> *hrasvadīrghayorvyatyayaḥ |*
> *madenu | madī harṣa ityasyāśīrlij lijyāśiṣyaj pratyayaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

In the Aptoryāma sacrifice, in the Acchāvāka's śastra of the atirikta-ukthya, the four Ṛks beginning पुराणमोकः (*purāṇamokaḥ*) are alternatively yājyā verses. It is also given in a sūtra: यदि नाधीयात्पुराणमोकः सख्यं शिवं वामिति चतस्रो याज्याः (*yadi nādhīyātpurāṇamokaḥ sakhyaṃ śivaṃ vāmiti catasro yājyāḥ*) (Ā. 9-11).

O Aśvins, your ancient friendship is an abode, to be resorted to, and auspicious, bringing welfare. And further, O leaders, guides of our rite, your wealth is in the woman of Jahnu's family (Jahnāvī). Renewing your friendly bonds, which bring happiness, we, being alike, made friends and one through the benefit of offering oblations, shall delight you both together, quickly, with the intoxicating Soma. [The block goes on with the grammar of सख्यं (*sakhyaṃ*) and the beginning of जह्नाव्यां (*jahnāvyāṃ*); it is omitted here.]

जह्नाव्यां (*jahnāvyāṃ*) means "belonging to Jahnu", and मदेम (*madema*) is from the root मदी (*madī*) in the sense of rejoicing. The rest is grammatical and is left to the Grammar section.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Aśvins) वां (*vāṃ*)—your
- पुराणं (*purāṇaṃ*)—ancient
- सख्यं (*sakhyaṃ*)—friendship
- ओकः (*okaḥ*)—worthy to be resorted to
- शिवं (*śivaṃ*)—bringing welfare
- नरा (*narā*)—leaders of the rite
- युवोः (*yuvoḥ*)—your
- द्रविणं (*draviṇaṃ*)—wealth
- जह्नाव्यां (*jahnāvyāṃ*)—is filled in the Jahnu family
- शिवानि (*śivāni*)—bringing happiness
- सख्या (*sakhyā*)—your friendship
- पुनः (*punaḥ*)—again
- कृष्णानाः (*kṛṣṇānāḥ*)—doing
- समानाः (*samānāḥ*)—we who are one with you (through friendship)
- मध्वा (*madhvā*)—with the sweet Soma juice
- सह (*saha*)—together
- नु (*nu*)—quickly
- मदेम (*madema*)—we shall gladden (you)

Gist

O Aśvins, your ancient friendship is worthy to be resorted to and brings welfare. Your wealth, O leaders of the rite, is filled in the Jahnu family. We, who renew your happiness-bringing friendship and are one with you, shall quickly delight you both together with the sweet Soma juice.

English translation

Your ancient friendship is desirable and auspicious; your wealth, leaders (of rites), is in the family of Jahnu : renewing that auspicious friend- ship, may we, your associates, delight you with the sweet (Soma juice).

Special Topics

These four Ṛks of this sūkta beginning पुराणमोकः (*purāṇamokaḥ*) (Ṛks 6, 7, 8, 9 of this sūkta), at the time of reciting the atirikta-ukthya mantras of the sacrifice called Aptoryāma, when the priest called Acchāvāka recites the śastra mantras, may alternatively be recited as yājyā mantras. This is set out in the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra यदि नाधीयात्पुराणमोकः सख्यं शिवं वामिति चतस्रो याज्याः (*yadi nādhīyātpurāṇamokaḥ sakhyaṃ śivaṃ vāmiti catasro yājyāḥ*) (Ā. 9-11).

ओकः (*okaḥ*)—सेव्यं (*sevyaṃ*): worthy of being resorted to. This is a word describing the friendship of the Aśvins. Ordinarily the word ओकः (*okaḥ*) means a comfortable dwelling-place. The Nirukta says: ओक इति निवासनामोच्यते । (*oka iti nivāsanāmocyate |*) (Ni. 3-3). The author of the Nirukta explains with an example that this word also indicates the extreme affection attached to that dwelling. (Ni. 3-3)

अथ स ओकः पुनरेव तदेति यत आगतो भवति । (*atha sa okaḥ punareva tadeti yata āgato bhavati |*) Because an adopted son feels attachment to his own home and returns there again, ओकः (*okaḥ*) is a synonym for one's own home.

The Nirukta author cites the Ṛk Saṃhitā passage

अधा चिदोकः पुनरित्स एत्या नो वाज्यभीषाळेतु नव्यः । (*adhā cidokaḥ punaritsa etyā no vājyabhīṣāḷetu navyaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-4-8)

and shows that the above meaning is made plain in this passage. The sense is that the comfort found in one's own home is found also in friendship with the Aśvins. The epithet शिव (*śiva*) is there to show that this same friendship is also auspicious.

जह्नाव्यां (*jahnāvyāṃ*)—जह्नु कुलजायां (*jahnu kulajāyāṃ*). The sense is that all the wealth of the Aśvins is filled in the Jahnu family. This word, indicating a lineage, is used in two places in the Ṛk Saṃhitā. Earlier, in

आ जह्नावीं समनसोप वाजैस्त्रिरहो भागं दधतीमयातं । (*ā jahnāvīṃ samanasopa vājaistriraho bhāgaṃ dadhatīmayātaṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-116-19)

too the prayer is addressed to the Aśvins: it prays that the Aśvins favour the people born in the Jahnu family. In the present Ṛk also Viśvāmitra, born in the Jahnu family, praises the Aśvins. The power of this same Viśvāmitra is described in many places. The Pañcaviṃśa Brāhmaṇa praises him: Viśvāmitra of the Jahnu line, by his own strength and by performing the sattra called Jātūrātra and so increasing his power, helped the Jāhnavas who were fighting the Vṛjīvants and won the kingdom for them. (Pa. Brā. 21-12)[?189]

अधीयत देवरातो रिक्षयोरुभयोर्यषिः । जह्नूनां चाधिपत्ये दैवे वेदे च गाथिनां ॥ (*adhīyata devarāto rikṣayorubhayoryaṣiḥ | jahnūnāṃ cādhipatye daive vede ca gāthināṃ* ‖) (Ai. Brā. 33-18)

The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa names this lineage thus: Śunaḥśepa, famed as Devarāta, became lord of the kingdom of the Jahnus and the Gādhis. It is the view of scholars that these names cannot denote different lineages. Some scholars hold that the Gādhi line also belongs to, and is included in, the Jāhnavī descent; this may be called a sound view. Here it is natural that Viśvāmitra, born in the Jahnu line, should praise the power of his own line.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अश्वि॑ना वा॒युना॑ यु॒वं सु॑दक्षा नि॒युद्भि॑ष्च स॒जोष॑सा युवाना ।
नास॑त्या ति॒रोअ॑ह्न्यं जुषा॒णा सोम॑ पिबतम॒स्त्रिधा॑ सुदानू ॥ ७ ॥

> *aśvinā vāyunā yuvaṃ sudakṣā niyudbhiṣca sajoṣasā yuvānā |*
> *nāsatyā tiroahnyaṃ juṣāṇā somaṃ pibatamasridhā sudānū ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अश्विना । वायुना । युवं । सुदक्षा । नियुद्धिः । च । सजोषसा । युवाना ।
> नासत्या । तिरोअह्न्यं । जुषाणा । सोमं । पिबतं । अस्त्रिधा । सुदानू इति
> सुदानू ॥ ७ ॥

> *aśvinā | vāyunā | yuvaṃ | sudakṣā | niyuddhiḥ | ca | sajoṣasā | yuvānā |*
> *nāsatyā | tiroahnyaṃ | juṣāṇā | somaṃ | pibataṃ | astridhā | sudānū iti*
> *sudānū ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सुदक्षा शोभनसामर्थ्योपेत् युवाना नित्यतरुण् नासत्या । न विद्यतेऽसत्यं ययोस्त् । सुदानू
> शोभनफलस्य दातारौ हे अश्विनौ वायुना नियुद्भिरश्वैश्च सजोषसा संगतौ जुषाणा
> सोमविषयप्रीतियुक्तावस्त्रिधानुपक्षीणौ युवं
> युवां तिरोअह्न्यमहि तिरोहिते हूयमानमिमं सोमं पिबतं ॥ नियुद्भिः ।
> यौतेः क्विप् । तिरोअह्न्यं । अह्नि भवमह्न्यं । भवे छंदसीति यत् । तिरो भूतमह्न्यं
> यस्मिन्काले स तिरोअह्न्यः । पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *sudakṣā śobhanasāmarthyopet yuvānā nityataruṇ nāsatyā | na vidyate*
> *'satyaṃ yayost | sudānū śobhanaphalasya dātārau he aśvinau vāyunā*
> *niyuddhiraścaiśca sajoṣasā saṃgatau juṣāṇā*
> *somaviṣayaprītiyuktāvastridhānupakṣīṇau yuvaṃ*
> *yuvāṃ tiroahnyamahi tirohite hūyamānamimaṃ somaṃ pibataṃ ‖ niyuddhiḥ |*
> *yauteḥ kvip | tiroahnyaṃ | ahni bhavamahnyaṃ | bhave chaṃdasīti yat | tiro bhūtamahnyaṃ yasminkāle sa tiroahnyaḥ |*
> *pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Aśvins, सुदक्षा (*sudakṣā*) endowed with fine capacity, युवाना (*yuvānā*) ever young, नासत्या (*nāsatyā*) those in whom there is no untruth (न विद्यतेऽसत्यं (*na vidyate 'satyaṃ*) yayoḥ), सुदानू (*sudānū*) givers of good reward: united with Vāyu and with the Niyut horses, सजोषसा (*sajoṣasā*) in company, जुषाणा (*juṣāṇā*) joyful about the Soma, अस्त्रिधा (*astridhā*) undiminished, you both drink this Soma that is offered at the तिरोअह्न्यं (*tiroahnyaṃ*) time, when the day has passed. [Grammar of नियुद्भिः (*niyuddhiḥ*) and तिरोअह्न्यं (*tiroahnyaṃ*) follows in the block and is left to the Grammar section.]?190

Word-to-word meaning

- सुदक्षा (*sudakṣā*)—endowed with excellent capacity
- युवाना (*yuvānā*)—ever young
- नासत्या (*nāsatyā*)—of true nature
- सुदानू (*sudānū*)—excellent givers, O Aśvins
- वायुना (*vāyunā*)—with Vāyu
- नियुद्भिः च (*niyuddhiḥ ca*)—and with their horses
- सजोषसा (*sajoṣasā*)—united
- आस्प्रिधा (*āspridhā*)—undiminished
- युवं (*yuvaṃ*)—you two
- तिरोअह्न्यं (*tiroahnyaṃ*)—pressed at the end of the day
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—this Soma juice
- पिबतं (*pibataṃ*)—drink

Gist

O Aśvins, endowed with excellent capacity, ever young, of true nature, excellent givers: you two, united with Vāyu and with the horses, and undiminished, drink this Soma juice pressed at the end of the day.

English translation

Ashwins, endowed with power, ever young, in whom is no untruth, unwearied, munificent, accepters (of libations), drink with Vayu and your steeds, rejoicing together, of the Soma libation offered at the close of day.

Special Topics

नासत्या (*nāsatyā*)—The authors of the Nirukta gave an etymology of this word, and the meaning was explained earlier. The view of Aurṇavābha, who says it means "free from untruth", was also given. But according to some others another etymology is possible: नाक-सत्या (*nāka-satyā*), that is, those who are in heaven. Just as the word भास्कर

(*bhāskara*), meaning light, becomes बाकुर (*bākura*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-1-8), and the word कर्मकार (*karmakāra*) becomes कर्मार (*karmāra*) (10-72-2), so नाक-सत्या (*nāka-satyā*) may become नासत्या (*nāsatyā*). Moreover, this view points out that the etymology agrees with the description of the Aśvins as sons of the heavenly world in Ṛks such as दिवो नपाताश्विना हुवे वां (*divo napātāśvinā huve vāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-61-4).

अस्त्रिधा (*astridhā*)—The root स्त्रिध् (*stridh*) is used in the two senses "to err" and "to perish". Hence अस्त्रिधा (*astridhā*) may mean "always going the right way", or "free from destruction". As said in many places, such as उदूहथुरणसो अस्त्रिधानैः (*udūhathuraṇaso astridhānaiḥ*), it is proper to give the meaning "free from destruction" in the present Ṛk also.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अश्वि॑ना॒ परि॑ वा॒मिष॑ः पुरू॒चीरी॒युर्गी॒र्भिर्यत॑माना॒ अमृ॑ध्राः ।
रथो॑ ह वामृत॒जा अद्रि॑जूत॒ः परि॒ द्यावा॑पृथि॒वी या॑ति स॒द्यः ॥ ८ ॥

> *aśvinā pari vāmiṣaḥ purūcīrīyurgīrbhiryatamānā amṛdhrāḥ |*
> *ratho ha vāmṛtajā adrijūtaḥ pari dyāvāpṛthivī yāti sadyaḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अश्विना । परि । वां । इषः । पुरूचीः । ईयुः । गीःभिः । यतमानाः । अमृध्राः ।
> रथः । ह । वां । ऋतजाः । अद्रिजूतः । परि । द्यावापृथिवी इति । याति । सद्यः ॥८॥

> *aśvinā | pari | vāṃ | iṣaḥ | purūcīḥ | īyuḥ | gīḥbhiḥ | yatamānāḥ | amṛdhrāḥ |*
> *rathaḥ | ha | vāṃ | ṛtajāḥ | adrijūtaḥ | pari | dyāvāpṛthivī iti | yāti | sadyaḥ ‖8‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अश्विनौ पुरूचीः पूर्वंचंति गच्छंतीति पुरूचीर्बहूनीषो हविर्लक्षणान्यन्नानि वां युवां परीयुः ।
> परितो गच्छंति । तथामृध्राः केनाप्यतिरस्कृता
> यतमानाः कर्मणि प्रवर्तमानाः स्तोतारो गीर्भिः स्तुतिलक्षणाभिर्वाग्भियुवां
> परिचरंति । ऋतजा ऋतस्योदकस्य जनयिता । ऋते यज्ञे प्रादुर्भवतीति वा ।
> अद्रिजूतः स्तोतृभिराकृष्टो नां युवयो रथो द्यावापृथिवी द्यावापृथिव्य
> सद्यस्तदानीमेव परि याति ह । सर्वतः प्राप्नोति खलु । अश्विनो रथस्य वेगवत्त्वे
> मंत्रवर्णः । यो वामश्विना मनसा जवीयान्रथः स्वश्वो विश आजिगाति । ऋग्वे.
> १–११७–२ । इति । अतः कारणादस्मदीयं यज्ञं प्रत्यागच्छतमिति भावः ॥ ईयुः । इण्
> गतावित्यस्य लिटि दीर्घ इणः कितीत्यभ्यासस्य दीर्घः । पादादित्पादनिघातः । यतमानाः ।
> यती प्रयत्न इत्यस्य शानचि रूपं । शपः पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे शानचो
> लसार्वधातुकस्वरेणानुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । ऋतजाः । जनेर्विट् । विड्वनोरित्यात्वं ।
> अद्रिजूतः ।
> जू इति सौत्रो धातुः । कर्मणि क्तः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *he aśvinau purūcīḥ pūrvaṃcaṃti gacchaṃtīti purūcīrbahūnīṣo havirlakṣaṇānyannāni vāṃ yuvāṃ parīyuḥ | parito gacchaṃti | tathāmṛdhrāḥ kenāpyatiraskṛtā*
> *yatamānāḥ karmaṇi pravartamānāḥ stotāro gīrbhiḥ stutilakṣaṇābhirvāgbhiyuvāṃ*
> *paricaraṃti | ṛtajā ṛtasyodakasya janayitā | ṛte yajñe prādurbhavatīti vā |*
> *adrijūtaḥ stotṛbhirākṛṣṭo nāṃ yuvayo ratho dyāvāpṛthivī dyāvāpṛthivya*
> *sadyastadānīmeva pari yāti ha | sarvataḥ prāpnoti khalu | aśvino rathasya vegavattve*
> *maṃtravarṇaḥ | yo vāmaśvinā manasā javīyānrathaḥ svaśvo viśa ājigāti | ṛgve.*
> *1-117-2 | iti | ataḥ kāraṇādasmadīyaṃ yajñaṃ pratyāgacchatamiti bhāvaḥ || īyuḥ | iṇ*
> *gatāvityasya liṭi dīrgha iṇaḥ kitītyabhyāsasya dīrghaḥ | pādāditpādanighātaḥ | yatamānāḥ |*
> *yatī prayatna ityasya śānaci rūpaṃ | śapaḥ pitvādanudāttatve śānaco lasārvadhātukasvareṇānudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | ṛtajāḥ | janerviṭ | viḍvanorityātvaṃ | adrijūtaḥ |*
> *jū iti sautro dhātuḥ | karmaṇi ktaḥ | tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvapadasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"Ashvins! The many (पुरूचीः (*purūcīḥ*), those that go forward) इषः (*iṣaḥ*), foods in the form of oblations, move round about you. So too the worshippers, unrebuked by anyone (अमृध्राः (*amṛdhrāḥ*)) and striving (यतमानाः (*yatamānāḥ*)) in the rite, attend you with their praise-words (गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)). ऋतजा (*ṛtajā*) is the begetter of ṛta, that is, of water; or it is that which comes into being in the ṛta, the sacrifice. अद्रिजूतः (*adrijūtaḥ*) means drawn by the worshippers. Your chariot goes round heaven and earth at once, instantly; it reaches everywhere." For the speed of the Ashvins' chariot he cites a mantra: "Ashvins, the chariot of yours that is swifter than thought, with good horses, comes to the peoples" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-117-2). Therefore, he says, the sense is: come to our sacrifice.

The rest of the block is grammar (īyuḥ, yatamānāḥ, ṛtajāḥ, adrijūtaḥ), which the Grammar section carries.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरूचीः (*purūcīḥ*)—very abundant
- इषः (*iṣaḥ*)—foods in the form of oblations
- वां परि (*vāṃ pari*)—towards you
- ईयुः (*īyuḥ*)—approach
- अमृध्राः (*amṛdhrāḥ*)—the blameless
- यतमानाः (*yatamānāḥ*)—those engaged in the rite, the worshippers
- गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)—with their praises (they serve)
- ऋतजाः (*ṛtajāḥ*)—that which sheds water in the form of rain
- अद्रिजूतः (*adrijūtaḥ*)—that which is drawn by praises
- वां (*vāṃ*)—your
- रथः (*rathaḥ*)—chariot
- सद्यः (*sadyaḥ*)—at once
- द्यावापृथिवी (*dyāvāpṛthivī*)—heaven and earth
- परि याति ह (*pari yāti ha*)—pervades, does it not

Gist

O Ashvins, very abundant foods in the form of oblations are offered towards you. The blameless worshippers, engaged in the rite, serve you with their praises. Your chariot, which sheds water in the form of rain and is drawn by the worshippers, at once pervades heaven and earth.

English translation

Ashwins, abundant (sacrificial) viands are presented to you, and blameless worshippers (salute you) with praises : your water-shedding car, attracted by the sacrificers, quickly compasses earth and heaven.

Special Topics

Purūcī: this word is formed from the root añc, of the sense of going, joined with the word puru. It is used to express a very great quantity or a multitude in number. Here it is an adjective of इषः (*iṣaḥ*).

Amṛdhrāḥ: the word mṛdhra means contempt; amṛdhra is that which lacks it. It is an adjective of the worshippers; the purport is "those who are scorned by no one".

Ṛtajāḥ: if ṛta is taken here to mean water, the word means "that which produces water". This word is an adjective of the chariot of the Ashvins. That the chariot of the Ashvins is a cause of the creation of water is perhaps nowhere to be found; yet what Sāyaṇa has explained is not without basis. Since there is the description "your chariot at once pervades heaven and earth" (नां रथः सद्यः द्यावा पृथिवी परि याति (*nāṃ rathaḥ sadyaḥ dyāvā pṛthivī pari yāti*)), and since there is also one view that the Ashvins are themselves heaven and earth, on that basis their chariot may be called a means of rain. It was said earlier, in the form of a story, that the union of heaven and earth is the cause of rain. Or one may infer that when rain falls, these two are united. The sentence कौ वैतां नावर्षं (*kau vaitāṃ nāvarṣaṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 4-27) was cited earlier: if they are separated there is no fall of rain at all. Hence it may be said that the chariot of the Ashvins, who are themselves of the form of heaven and earth, became also the cause of the fall of rain. Sāyaṇa has explained ऋतस्य उदकस्य जनयिता (*ṛtasya udakasya janayitā*). Or, as another explanation, ऋते यज्ञे प्रादुर्भवतीति वा (*ṛte yajñè prādurbhavatīti vā*), "that which is born in the sacrifice". What the basis of this explanation is cannot be said.

Adrijūtaḥ: स्तोतृभिराकृष्टः (*stotṛbhirākṛṣṭaḥ*), meaning "drawn by the worshippers". For this word the scholar Monier Williams, in his Sanskrit-English Dictionary, gives "Excited by the friction of Stones", that is, impelled by the rubbing of stones, meaning pressed out, and cites this very Ṛk. This meaning too cannot be called unsound. If the two words ṛtajāḥ and adrijūtaḥ are taken as synonyms of the Soma juice, the sense is that the Soma juice is produced for the sacrifice and is crushed and pressed out with stones. To state the purport thus is more fitting to the context than Sāyaṇa's explanation. To fit the purport to this Ṛk as Sāyaṇa explains it is rather laborious work.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अश्वि॑ना मधु॒षुत्त॑मो यु॒वाकु॒ः सोम॒स्तं पा॑त॒मा ग॑तं दुरो॒णे ।
रथो॑ ह वा॒ं भूरि॒ वर्प॒ः करि॑क्रत्सु॒ताव॑तो निष्कृ॒तमा ग॑मिष्ठः ॥ ९ ॥

> *aśvinā madhuṣuttamo yuvākuḥ somastaṃ pātamā gataṃ duroṇe |*
> *ratho ha vāṃ bhūri varpaḥ karikratsutāvato niṣkṛtamāgamiṣṭhaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अश्विना । मधुसःत्कमः । युवाकुः । सोमः । तं । पातं । आ । गतं । दुरोणी ।
> रथः । ह । वां । भूरि । वर्पः । करिक्रत् । सुत्यवतः । निःकृतं । आगमिष्यः ॥ ९ ॥

> *aśvinā | madhusaḥtkamaḥ | yuvākuḥ | somaḥ | taṃ | pātaṃ | ā |*
> *gataṃ | duroṇī |*
> *rathaḥ | ha | vāṃ | bhūri | varpaḥ | karikrat | sutyavataḥ | niḥkṛtaṃ |*
> *āgamiṣyaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अश्विनौ यः सोमो मधुषुत्तमो मधुरसमत्यंतं प्रेरय्यन्युवाकुयुवां कामयमानो वर्तते । यद्वा ।
> युवाकुर्वसतीवरीप्रभृतिभिर्मिश्रित
> इत्यर्थः । तमिमं सोमं पातं । पिबतं । दुरोणेऽस्माकं गृह आ गतं । आगच्छतं।
> भूरि प्रभूतं वर्पो वारकं तेजः रूपं वा सर्वैर्वर्णीयं धनं वा करिक्रत्सुनः
> पुनः कुर्वणां युवयो रथः सुतवतः सोममभिषुतवतो यजमानस्य निष्कृतः ।
> निरित्येष समित्येतस्य स्थाने । नि. १२–७ । इति यास्कः । संस्कारि । यद्वा । संस्कृतं
> गृहमागमिष्ठोऽतिशयेनागच्छन् भवति ॥ युवाकुः । यातेः कटिकुषिभ्यां काकुरिति
> बाहुलकादस्मादपि भवति । प्रत्ययस्वरेण मध्योदात्तः । करिक्रत् । करोतेर्यज्लुकि
> शतरि दाधर्ति दर्धर्ति दर्धर्षित्यादिना चुत्वाभावे यणादेशे कृतेऽंगस्यानृकारांतत्पादभ्यासस्य
> रिगागमो न प्राप्नोतीति सोऽपि निपात्यते ॥ अभ्यस्तस्वरः । निष्कृतं ।
> करोतेरादिकर्मणि क्तः । संस्कर्तुं प्रवृक्त इत्यर्थः । थाथादिस्वरः ॥

> *he aśvinau yaḥ somo madhuṣuttamo madhurasamatyaṃtaṃ*
> *prerayyanyuvākuyuvāṃ kāmayamāno vartate | yadvā |*
> *yuvākurvasatīvarīprabhṛtibhirmiśrita*
> *ityarthaḥ | tamimaṃ somaṃ pātaṃ | pibataṃ | duroṇe 'smākaṃ gṛha ā*
> *gataṃ | āgacchataṃ|*
> *bhūri prabhūtaṃ varpo vārakaṃ tejaḥ rūpaṃ vā sarvaivarraṇīyaṃ*
> *dhanaṃ vā karikratsunaḥ*
> *punaḥ kurvaṇāṃ yuvayo rathaḥ sutavataḥ somamabhiṣutavato*
> *yajamānasya niṣkṛtaḥ |*
> *nirityeṣa samityetasya sthāne | ni. 12-7 | iti yāskaḥ | saṃskāri | yadvā |*
> *saṃskṛtaṃ gṛhamāgamiṣṭho 'tiśayenāgacchan bhavati ‖ yuvākuḥ | yāteḥ*
> *kaṭikuṣibhyāṃ kākuriti*
> *bāhulakādasmādapi bhavati | pratyayasvareṇa madhyodāttaḥ | karikrat*
> *| karoteryajluki*
> *śatari dādharti dardharti dardharṣityādinā cutvābhāve yaṇādeśe kṛte*
> *'ṃgasyānṛkārāṃtatpādabhyāsasya rigāgamo na prāpnotīti so 'pi*
> *nipātyate ‖ abhyastasvaraḥ | niṣkṛtaṃ |*
> *karoterādikarmaṇi ktaḥ | saṃskartuṃ pravṛkta ityarthaḥ |*
> *thāthādisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"Ashvins! The Soma that is मधुषुत्तमो (*madhuṣuttamo*), sending forth sweet juice to the utmost, is युवाकुः (*yuvākuḥ*), desiring you; or else युवाकुः (*yuvākuḥ*) means mixed with vasatīvarī waters and the like. Drink (पातं (*pātaṃ*)) this Soma and come (आ गतं (*ā gataṃ*)) to our house (दुरोणे (*duroṇe*)). भूरि (*bhūri*) is abundant; वर्पः (*varpaḥ*) is protecting brilliance, or form, or wealth to be chosen by all. Your chariot, करिक्रत् (*karikrat*), producing this again and again, is आगमिष्ठः (*āgamiṣṭhaḥ*), most coming, to the निष्कृतं (*niṣkṛtaṃ*) of the offerer who has pressed the Soma." Here निः (*niḥ*) stands in place of सम् (*sam*), according to Yāska (Ni. 12-7); निष्कृतं (*niṣkṛtaṃ*) is thus the prepared, refined place. Or: the chariot comes most surely to the house that has been prepared. The remainder (युवाकुः (*yuvākuḥ*), करिक्रत् (*karikrat*), निष्कृतं (*niṣkṛtaṃ*): formation and accent) is grammar.?191

Word-to-word meaning

- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—O Ashvins
- सोमः (*somaḥ*)—this Soma
- मधषुत्तमः (*madhaṣuttamaḥ*)—full of sweet juice?192
- युवाकुः (*yuvākuḥ*)—desiring you
- तं (*taṃ*)—this Soma
- पातं (*pātaṃ*)—drink
- दुरोणे (*duroṇe*)—to our house
- आ गतं (*ā gataṃ*)—come
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—abundant
- वर्पः (*varpaḥ*)—brilliance
- करिक्रत् (*karikrat*)—making it spread again and again
- वां (*vāṃ*)—your
- रथः (*rathaḥ*)—chariot
- सुतवर्तः (*sutavartaḥ*)—of the sacrificer who has pressed the Soma juice?193
- निष्कृतं (*niṣkṛtaṃ*)—to the sacrificial house
- आगमिष्ठः (*āgamiṣṭhaḥ*)—may it come

Gist

O Ashvins, this Soma is full of sweet juice and desires you. Drink this Soma. Come to our house. May your chariot, which is abundant and makes its brilliance spread again and again, come to the sacrificial house of the sacrificer who has pressed the Soma juice.

English translation

Ashwins, this most sweet Soma is mixed ; drink it : come to (our) dwelling: your car, repeatedly bestowing wealth, is coming to the appointed place of the offerer of the libation.

Special Topics

Duroṇe: this word is read among the names of houses (Ni. 3-13). It means a dwelling-house. But in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā it is generally used in the sense of the sacrificial house.

Varpaḥ: this word is read among the names of form (Ni. 3-7). In this word beauty and radiance are suggested together. The word is used when describing a form that is full of lustre and attractive.

In the present Ṛk two or three explanations of the meaning of this word are given: वर्षः वारकं तेजः, रूपं वा, सर्वैः वरणीयं धनं वा (*varṣaḥ vārakaṃ tejaḥ, rūpaṃ vā, sarvai: varaṇīyaṃ dhanaṃ vā*). It is indicated that it may mean brilliance, or form, or wealth desired by all.

The sentence भूरि वर्षः करिक्रत् (*bhūri varṣaḥ karikrat*) shows that two kinds of meaning are possible for the word varṣa. Karikrat means making something spread again and again; bhūri means very abundant. If the meaning given is that the chariot of the Ashvins makes brilliance spread again and again, taking varṣa as brilliance, then, since the chariot of the Ashvins is itself full of brilliance, its brilliance spreads whenever that chariot comes to the sacrificial house: this is one kind of purport. Secondly, since however many times their chariot comes the sacrificer's prosperity increases, भूरि वर्षः करिक्रत् (*bhūri varṣaḥ karikrat*) also fits when the meaning is given in terms of wealth. But to say that it means the radiant form, which is the established sense of the word varṣa, is proper in the present context. [Karikrata is also the name of the seer of the mantra 10-136-5.]

Niṣkṛta: this word is used in the sense of a house. As to how this purport is obtained, the author of the Nirukta has given its explanation and illustrated it with an example.

निरित्येष समित्येतस्य स्थाने (*nirityeṣa samityetasya sthāne*) (Ni. 12-2). The prefix niḥ is used in the sense of sam. Saṃskṛta means a place that has been refined. But "refined" here may be an arrangement made so that a dwelling-place is a place of assignation and secret. The author of the Nirukta, citing the Ṛk यदादीध्ये न दविषाण्येभिः परायध्योऽव हीये सखिभ्यः । न्युप्ताश्च बभ्रवो वाचमक्रत्र एमीदेषां निष्कृतं जारिणीव ॥ (*yadādīdhye na daviṣāṇyebhiḥ parāyadhyo 'va hīye sakhibhyaḥ | nyuptāśca babhravo vācamakratra emīdeṣāṃ niṣkṛtaṃ jāriṇīva* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-34-)[?194], has shown that there the word niṣkṛta means a place of tryst. A woman of loose conduct going to the niṣkṛta and joining him means going to a secret place and meeting him.

But this purport is not found everywhere. A refined house may also mean the preparations made for sacrifices and the like. In the present context it means the sacrificial house of the sacrificer.

_______ : 0 : _______

Sūkta 59 (Maṇḍala 3)

The fifty-ninth sūkta.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> मित्रो जनानिति नवर्चं षष्ठं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं त्रैष्टुभं मैत्रं । मित्रो
> मैत्रं चतुर्गायत्र्यंतमित्यनुक्रमणिका । आदितः पंच त्रिष्टुभः शिष्टाश्चतस्रो
> गायत्र्यः । मित्रो देवता ॥ अग्निहोत्रार्थे पयसि वर्षविंदुपतने मित्रो जनानित्यनया
> समिधमादध्यात् । सूत्रितं च । मित्रो जनान्यातयति ब्रुवाण इति समिदाधानं । आ. ३–११ ।
> इति ॥

> *mitro janāniti navarcaṃ ṣaṣṭhaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ maitraṃ | mitro*
> *maitraṃ caturgāyatryaṃtamityanukramaṇikā | āditaḥ paṃca triṣṭubhaḥ śiṣṭāścatasro*
> *gāyatryaḥ | mitro devatā ‖ agnihotrārthe payasi varṣaviṃdupatane mitro janānityanayā samidhamādadhyāt | sūtritaṃ ca | mitro*
> *janānyātayati bruvāṇa iti samidādhānaṃ | ā. 3-11 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning मित्रो जनान् (*mitro janān*) has nine ṛks and is the sixth sūkta; its seer is Viśvāmitra, its metre is triṣṭubh, and it is addressed to Mitra. The Anukramaṇikā says: मित्रो मैत्रं चतुर्गायत्र्यंतं (*mitro maitraṃ caturgāyatryaṃtaṃ*). The first five ṛks are triṣṭubh, the remaining four gāyatrī; the deity is Mitra. Use: when, in the milk drawn for the agnihotra, drops of rain fall, one should place a fuel-stick (samidh) on the fire with this ṛk मित्रो जनान् (*mitro janān*). It is also laid down in the sūtra: मित्रो जनान्यातयति ब्रुवाण इति समिदाधानं (*mitro janānyātayati bruvāṇa iti samidādhānaṃ*) (Ā. 3-11).[?195]

Anuvāda

This sūkta, "Mitro janān", is the sixth sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It contains nine ṛks. Viśvāmitra is the seer of this sūkta; Mitra is the deity; the metre is triṣṭubh. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said: मित्रो मैत्रं चतुर्गायत्र्यंतं (*mitro maitraṃ caturgāyatryaṃtaṃ*). In this sūkta the first five ṛks are in the triṣṭubh metre; the remaining four ṛks are in the gāyatrī metre; Mitra is the deity. It is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, मित्रो जनान्यातयति ब्रुवाण इति समिदाधानं (*mitro janānyātayati bruvāṇa iti samidādhānaṃ*) (Ā. 3-21), that when, while milking for the agnihotra, drops of rain fall in the milk, a samidh-offering should be made in the fire with the ṛk "Mitro janān".

> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—५९
> मंडल—३ ॥ अनुवाक—५ ॥ सूक्त—५९ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—५, ६ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये— ९॥
> ऋषिः—विश्वामित्रः ॥
> देवता—अश्विनौ॥
> छंदः—१–५. त्रिष्टुप् । ६–९ गायत्री ॥

> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—59*
> *maṃḍala—3 ‖ anuvāka—5 ‖ sūkta—59 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—5, 6 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè— 9‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—viśvāmitraḥ ‖*
> *devatā—aśvinau‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—1-5. triṣṭup | 6-9 gāyatrī ‖*

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Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मि॒त्रो जना॑न्यातयति ब्रुवा॒णो मि॒त्रो दा॑धार पृथि॒वीमु॒त द्याम् ।
मि॒त्रः कृ॒ष्टीरनि॑मिषा॒भि च॑ष्टे मि॒त्राय॑ ह॒व्यं घृ॒तव॑ज्जुहोत ॥ १ ॥

> *mitro janānyātayati bruvāṇo mitro dādhāra pṛthivīmuta dyām |*
> *mitraḥ kṛṣṭīranimiṣābhi caṣṭe mitrāya havyaṃ ghṛtavajjuhota ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मित्रः । जनान् । यातयति । ब्रुवाणः । मित्रः । दाधार । पृथिवीं । उत । द्यां ।
> मित्रः । कृष्टीः । अनिमिषा । अभि । चष्टे । मित्राय । हव्यं । धृतवत् । जुहोत ॥१॥

> *mitraḥ | janān | yātayati | bruvāṇaḥ | mitraḥ | dādhāra | pṛthivīṃ |*
> *uta | dyāṃ |*
> *mitraḥ | kṛṣṭīḥ | animiṣā | abhi | caṣṭe | mitrāya | havyaṃ | dhṛtavat |*
> *juhota ‖1‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ब्रुवाणः स्तूयमानः शब्दं कुर्वाणो वा मित्रः । प्रकर्षेण सर्वैर्मायते ज्ञायते तथा सर्वान्वृष्टिप्रदानेन त्रायत इति वा मित्रः सूरः । जनान्
> कर्षकादिजनान्यातयति । कृष्यादिकर्मसु प्रयत्नं कारयति । तथा मित्र एव पृथिवीमुतापि च द्यामेतावुभौ लोकौ वृष्टिद्वारान्नं यागांश्च जनयन् दाधार । धारयति । तथा सति मित्रोऽनिमिषानिमिषेणानुग्रहदृष्ट्वा कृष्टीः कर्मवतो मनुष्यानभि चष्टे । सर्वतः पश्यति । एतत्सर्वं ज्ञात्वा हे ऋत्विजो धृतवदुपस्तरणाभिघारणयुक्तं हव्यं हवनयोग्यं पुरोडाशादिकं तस्मै मित्राय देवाय जुहोत ।

> *bruvāṇaḥ stūyamānaḥ śabdaṃ kurvāṇo vā mitraḥ | prakarṣeṇa sarvairmāyate jñāyate tathā sarvānvṛṣṭipradānena trāyata iti vā mitraḥ sūraḥ | janān*
> *karṣakādijanānyātayati | kṛṣyādikarmasu prayatnaṃ kārayati | tathā mitra eva pṛthivīmutāpi ca dyāmetāvubhau lokau vṛṣṭidvārānnaṃ yāgāṃśca janayan dādhāra | dhārayati | tathā sati mitro 'nimiṣānimiṣeṇānugrahadṛṣṭvā kṛṣṭīḥ karmavato manuṣyānabhi caṣṭe | sarvataḥ paśyati | etatsarvaṃ jñātvā he ṛtvijo dhṛtavadupastaraṇābhighāraṇayuktaṃ havyaṃ havanayogyaṃ puroḍāśādikaṃ tasmai mitrāya devāya juhota |*

> जुहुत । प्रयच्छतेत्यर्थः । उक्तार्थं यास्को ब्रवीति । मित्रो जनान्यातयति ब्रुवाणः शब्दं कुर्वन् । मित्र एव धारयति प्रथिवीं च दिवं च । मित्रः कृष्टीरनिमिषन्नभिपश्यतीति । कृष्टय इति मनुष्यनाम कर्मवंतो भवंति विकृष्टदेहा वा । मित्राय हव्यं धृतवज्जुहोतेति व्याख्यातं । जुहोतिर्दानकर्मा । नि. १०–२२ ।

> इति ॥ यातयति । यती प्रयत्न इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लटि रूपं । दाधार ।
> तुजादीनामित्यभ्यासस्य दीर्घः । जुहोत । जुहोतेर्लोटि प्रत्ययस्य तबादेशः । गुणः ।
> निघातः ॥

> *juhuta | prayacchatetyarthaḥ | uktārthaṃ yāsko bravīti | mitro janānyātayati*
> *bruvāṇaḥ śabdaṃ kurvan | mitra eva dhārayati prathivīṃ ca divaṃ ca |*
> *mitraḥ kṛṣṭīranimiṣannabhipaśyatīti | kṛṣṭaya iti manuṣyanāma karmavaṃto bhavaṃti vikṛṣṭadehā vā |*
> *mitrāya havyaṃ dhṛtavajjuhoteti vyākhyātaṃ | juhotirdānakarmā | ni. 10-22 |*
> *iti ‖ yātayati | yatī prayatna ityasya ṇyaṃtasya laṭi rūpaṃ | dādhāra |*
> *tujādīnāmityabhyāsasya dīrghaḥ | juhota | juhoterloṭi pratyayasya tabādeśaḥ | guṇaḥ |*
> *nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

ब्रुवाणः (*bruvāṇaḥ*) means being praised, or making sound; this is Mitra. Mitra is so called because he is widely known (मायते (*māyate*), from प्रकर्षेण (*prakarṣeṇa*)) by all, or because he protects all by granting rain; Mitra is the sun. He यातयति (*yātayati*) the people, the farmers and others: he makes them strive in tilling and other works. Likewise Mitra alone sustains (दाधार (*dādhāra*)) both earth and heaven, these two worlds, by producing food and sacrifices through rain. That being so, Mitra with an unwinking, gracious gaze (अनिमिषा (*animiṣā*)) looks all around (अभि चष्टे (*abhi caṣṭe*)) on the कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*), men engaged in work. Knowing all this, O priests, offer (जुहोत (*juhota*)) to that god Mitra the oblation fit for offering, such as the puroḍāśa, accompanied by ghee (धृतवत् (*dhṛtavat*)), with the spreading of ghee beneath and the pouring of it over.

Sāyaṇa completes the gloss of the word जुहोत (*juhota*): it means "give". He then cites Yāska for the sense already stated. "Mitra urges men on, speaking, that is, making a sound. Mitra alone sustains the earth and the heaven. Mitra looks upon the कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*) without closing his eyes." Yāska adds that कृष्टयः (*kṛṣṭayaḥ*) is a name for men, who are active, or whose bodies are extended. "मित्राय हव्यं धृतवज्जुहोत (*mitrāya havyaṃ dhṛtavajjuhota*)" is already explained; जुहोति (*juhoti*) is a verb of giving (Ni. 10-22).

Word-to-word meaning

- ब्रुवाणः (*bruvāṇaḥ*)—the one who is praised
- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—the Sun, in the form of Mitra
- जनान् (*janān*)—the people
- यातयति (*yātayati*)—impels them each to their own works
- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—that same Mitra
- पृथिवीं (*pṛthivīṃ*)—the earth
- उत (*uta*)—and
- द्यां (*dyāṃ*)—the heaven too
- दाधार (*dādhāra*)—has upheld
- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—that same Mitra
- अनिमिषा (*animiṣā*)—with a favouring gaze
- कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*)—all people
- अभि चष्टे (*abhi caṣṭe*)—looks around upon (O priests)
- धृतवत् (*dhṛtavat*)—endowed with ghee
- हव्यं (*havyaṃ*)—the oblation
- मित्राय (*mitrāya*)—addressed to that Mitra
- जुहोत (*juhota*)—offer in the form of an oblation

Gist

Mitra, who is praised by the singers, impels the people to their own works. That same Mitra has upheld the earth and the heaven. That same Mitra looks around upon all people with a favouring gaze. O priests, offer the oblation, endowed with ghee, as an oblation addressed to that Mitra.

English translation

Mitra, when praised, animates men to exertion : Indra sustains both the earth and heaven : Mitra looks upon men with unclosing eyes : offer to Mitra the oblations of clarified butter.

Special Topics

The author of the Nirukta too has explained the purport of this mantra: मित्रः जनान् आयातयति प्रब्रुवाणः । शब्दं कुर्वन् । मित्र एव धारयति पृथिवीं च दिवं च । मित्रः कृष्टी अनिमिषन् अभिविपश्यति इति । कृष्टयः इति मनुष्यनाम । कर्मवंतः भवंति । विकृष्टदेहा वा .... ॥ (*mitraḥ janān āyātayati prabruvāṇaḥ | śabdaṃ kurvan | mitra eva dhārayati pṛthivīṃ ca divaṃ ca | mitraḥ kṛṣṭī animiṣan abhivipaśyati iti | kṛṣṭayaḥ iti manuṣyanāma | karmavaṃtaḥ bhavaṃti | vikṛṣṭadehā vā .... ‖*) (Ni. 10-22)

Mitra, making an exhorting sound, leads the people along the good path. Mitra alone upholds and protects both heaven and earth. Without touching a limit he surveys all the people completely. Here the word कृष्ण (*kṛṣṇa*)[?198] is a synonym for human beings. Because the body is always engaged in action and is extended, this is a word used as an epithet.

Sāyaṇa's view is that the word Mitra is a synonym of the Sun. He has shown the meaning of the parts of the word, saying that the word Mitra is formed by the union of the two roots मि (*mi*) and त्रा (*trā*): प्रकर्षेण सर्वैर्मीयते ज्ञायते तथा सर्वान् वृष्टिप्रदानेन त्रायत इति ना मित्रः सूर्यः । (*prakarṣeṇa sarvairmīyate jñāyate tathā sarvān vṛṣṭipradānena trāyata iti nā mitraḥ sūryaḥ* |). He is fully known by all, and he protects all. Because he has these two qualities, the Sun is what the word Mitra denotes.

Since the three actions specified in this mantra also belong to the Sun, the eye of the world, the sense referring to the Sun is proper. They are: impelling men to their respective works; upholding heaven and earth together; and viewing everything completely in the form of his own radiance. These are the three functions.

अवत इत्येष हीदग्ं सर्वमवति (*avata ityeṣa hīdagṃ sarvamavati*) (Śa. Brā. 8-7-3-13). "This Sun alone makes the whole world animate" and so on: the power of the Sun thus described is indicated here by the word यातयति (*yātayati*). Moreover, praises such as सविता सर्वस्य प्रसविता (*savitā sarvasya prasavitā*) are well known. And:

आदित्यास्ता पृष्ठे सादयामीति । इयं ना अदितिरस्यामेवैनमेतत्पतिष्ठायां प्रतिष्ठापयत्यंतरिक्षस्य धर्त्रिं विष्टंभनीं दिशामधिपत्नीं भुवनानामित्यंतरिक्षस्य ह्येष धर्ता विष्टंभनो दिशामधिपतिर्भुवनानामूर्मिर्दप्रोऽपामसीतिरसः .... ॥ (*ādityāstā pṛṣṭhe sādayāmīti | iyaṃ nā aditirasyāmevainametatpatiṣṭhāyāṃ pratiṣṭhāpayatyaṃtarikṣasya dhartriṃ viṣṭaṃbhanīṃ diśāmadhipatnīṃ bhuvanānāmityaṃtarikṣasya hyeṣa dhartā viṣṭaṃbhano diśāmadhipatirbhuvanānāmūrmirdapro 'pāmasītirasaḥ .... ||*) (Śa. Brā. 8-2-1-10)

In sentences of this kind all the qualities of the Sun mentioned above are stated together. This Āditya, the son of Aditi who supports all, is the light of the universe. He is the upholder of all the worlds beginning with the atmosphere, the lord of the universe, Prajāpati, the eye of the world; thus all the qualities are described.

कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*)—for the word कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) he has given the meaning कर्मवतः मनुष्यान् (*karmavataḥ manuṣyān*), "men engaged in action". Since it is described that Mitra, in the form of the Sun, has upheld both heaven and earth, one would not be wrong in saying that the word कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) means all beings, including the gods.

यस्येक्ष्वाकुरुप व्रते रेवान्मराय्येधते दिवीव पंच कृष्टयः । (*yasyekṣvākurupa vrate revānmarāyyedhate divīva paṃca kṛṣṭayaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-60-9)

In passages of this kind a likeness is stated between the five कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) of the earth and the five कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) of the heavenly world. Moreover, when it is told who the five कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*) are, it is said: मनुष्याः पितरो देवा गंधर्वोरगराक्षसाः (*manuṣyāḥ pitaro devā gaṃdharvoragarākṣasāḥ*) (Bṛ. De. Ni. 68); the five groups, gods, men and the rest, together are the five कृष्टि (*kṛṣṭi*). Therefore there can be no fault in stating the above meaning here.

अभिचष्टे (*abhicaṣṭe*)—when the root चक्ष (*cakṣa*) is joined with the prefix अभि (*abhi*), it has the sense "look around", and also the sense "shine so as to be seen all around by all". The author of the Nirukta has given for the word चक्षसे (*cakṣase*) the purport दर्शनाय (*darśanāya*) (Ni. 9-27), "for seeing", and for the word अभिचष्टे (*abhicaṣṭe*) the purport अभिपश्यति (*abhipaśyati*) (Ni. 10-22), सर्वतः पश्यति (*sarvataḥ paśyati*), "sees well all around". The above sense is found in examples such as महे रणाय चक्षसे (*mahe raṇāya cakṣase*) (10-9-1). And:

महत्ते विष्णो अभिचक्ष्यं कृतं पश्येम तुर्वशं यदुं । (*mahatte viṣṇo abhicakṣyaṃ kṛtaṃ paśyema turvaśaṃ yaduṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-4-7)

Here the word अभिचक्ष्य (*abhicakṣya*) means प्रकाश्य (*prakāśya*), that is, to make oneself manifest and visible so that others can see fully. In the present Ṛk it may be said that Āditya, who has upheld heaven and earth together, possesses two kinds of power: the power of illuminating the whole world and the power of being the eye of the world are found in him alone.

चित्रं देवानामुदगादनीकं चक्षुर्मित्रस्य वरुणस्याग्नेः । आप्रा द्यावापृथिवी अंतरिक्षं सूर्य आत्मा जगतस्तस्थुषश्च ॥ (*citraṃ devānāmudagādanīkaṃ cakṣurmitrasya varuṇasyāgneḥ | āprā dyāvāpṛthivī aṃtarikṣaṃ sūrya ātmā jagatastasthuṣaśca ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-15-1)

In mantras of this kind all the qualities mentioned in the present Ṛk are described together. This same mantra is recited in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā with a slight variation. The text there is:

मित्रो जनान्यातयति प्रजानन्मित्रो दाधार वृद्धिवीमुत द्यां । मित्रः कृष्टीरनिमिषाभिचष्टे सत्याय हव्यं धृतवद्विधेम ॥ (*mitro janānyātayati prajānanmitro dādhāra vṛddhivīmuta dyāṃ | mitraḥ kṛṣṭīranimiṣābhicaṣṭe satyāya havyaṃ dhṛtavadvidhema ‖*) (Tai. Saṃ. 3-4-11-5)

In place of ब्रुवाणः (*bruvāṇaḥ*) of the present Ṛk, the Taittirīya Saṃhitā has प्रजानन् (*prajānan*), and in the second half, in place of मित्राय (*mitrāya*) it has सत्याय (*satyāya*). Since the cited mantra has प्रजानन् (*prajānan*) in the first half, for the word अभिचष्टे (*abhicaṣṭe*) the meaning प्रकाशयति (*prakāśayati*),

"makes everything shine", fits. And it is natural that, in सत्याय हव्यं (*satyāya havyaṃ*), the word सत्य (*satya*) is a synonym of the word मित्र (*mitra*). In the sacrifice called Devasū, the injunction that the offering be made to Mitra, whose nature is truth, shows this non-difference: देवसुवां हविष्णु मित्रस्य सत्यस्य (*devasuvāṃ haviṣṇu mitrasya satyasya*) and so on. This subject will be explained in the Special Topics of the next Ṛk.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र स मि॑त्र॒ मर्तो॑ अस्तु॒ प्रय॑स्वा॒न्यस्त॑ आदित्य॒ शिक्ष॑ति व्र॒तेन॑ ।
न ह॑न्यते॒ न जी॑यते॒ त्वोतो॒ नैन॒मंहो॑ अश्नो॒त्यन्ति॑तो॒ न दू॒रात् ॥ २ ॥

> *pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvānyasta āditya śikṣati vratena |*
> *na hanyate na jīyate tvoto nainamaṃho aśnotyantito na dūrāt ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । सः । मित्र । मर्तः । अस्तु । प्रयस्वान् । यः । ते । आदित्य । शिक्षति । व्रतेन ।
> न । हन्यते । न । जीयते । त्वाऊतः । न । एनं । अ०हः । अश्नोति । अंतितः । न ।
> दूरात् ॥ २ ।

> *pra | saḥ | mitra | martaḥ | astu | prayasvān | yaḥ | te | āditya |*
> *śikṣati | vratena |*
> *na | hanyate | na | jīyate | tvāūtaḥ | na | enaṃ | aohaḥ | aśnoti |*
> *aṃtitaḥ | na |*
> *dūrāt ‖ 2 |*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवसुवां हविषु मित्रस्य सत्यस्य प्र स मित्रेति याज्या । एष्यव प्रातर्होमस्य कालात्ययनिमित्ते मृत्रे चरौ याज्या । सूत्रितं च । प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु
> प्रयस्वांस्तां नष्टवान्महिमाय पृच्छते । आ. ४–११ । इति ॥ तत इष्टिर्मित्रः
> सूर्योऽभि यो महिना दिवं प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वानिति संस्थितायां ।
> आ. ३–१२ । इति च ॥
> हे आदित्य व्रतेन यज्ञेन युक्तो यो मनुष्यस्ते तुभ्यं शिक्षति हनिर्लक्षणमन्नं ददाति हे मित्र स मर्तो मनुष्यः प्रयस्वानन्नवान् प्रास्तु । प्रभवतु ।
> तोतस्त्वया रक्षितः स मनुष्यः केनापि न हन्यते न बाध्यते । न जीयते ! नाभिभूयते च। एनं तुभ्यं हविर्दत्तवंतं पुरुषमंहः पापमंतितः समीपान्नाश्नोति।
> न प्राप्नोति । दूरादपि न प्राप्नोति ॥ शिक्षतिर्दानकर्मा । व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं

> यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । जीयते । जयतेः कर्मणि यक्यकृत्सार्वधातुकयोरिति दीर्घः । त्वोतः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदस्वरः । अश्नोति । अशू व्याप्तौ । स्वादिः । व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं ॥

> *devasuvāṃ haviṣu mitrasya satyasya pra sa mitrèti yājyā | eṣyava prātarhomasya kālātyayanimitte mṛtre carau yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | pra sa mitra marto astu*
> *prayasvāṃstāṃ naṣṭavānmahimāya pṛcchate | ā. 4-11 | iti ‖ tata iṣṭirmitraḥ*
> *sūryo 'bhi yo mahinā divaṃ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvāniti saṃsthitāyāṃ |*
> *ā. 3-12 | iti ca ‖*
> *he āditya vratena yajñena yukto yo manuṣyaste tubhyaṃ śikṣati hanirlakṣaṇamannaṃ dadāti he mitra sa marto manuṣyaḥ prayasvānannavān prāstu | prabhavatu |*
> *totastvayā rakṣitaḥ sa manuṣyaḥ kenāpi na hanyate na bādhyate | na jīyate ! nābhibhūyate ca| enaṃ tubhyaṃ havirdattavaṃtaṃ puruṣamaṃhaḥ pāpamaṃtitaḥ samīpānnāśnoti|*
> *na prāpnoti | dūrādapi na prāpnoti ‖ śikṣatirdānakarmā | vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | jīyate | jayateḥ karmaṇi yakyakṛtsārvadhātukayoriti*
> *dīrghaḥ | tvotaḥ | tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvapadasvaraḥ | aśnoti | aśū vyāptau |*
> *svādiḥ | vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ ‖*

Summary

Viniyoga: in the offerings of the देवसुवां हविषु (*devasuvāṃ haviṣu*) to Mitra, the true, "प्र स मित्र (*pra sa mitra*)" is the yājyā. It is likewise the yājyā in the caru offered to Mitra when the time of the morning homa has been exceeded. This is laid down in the sūtra (Ā. 4-11), "प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वांस्तां नष्टवान्महिमाय पृच्छते (*pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvāṃstāṃ naṣṭavānmahimāya pṛcchate*)", and in the sūtra (Ā. 3-12), "then the iṣṭi to Mitra: सूर्योऽभि यो महिना दिवं (*sūryo 'bhi yo mahinā divaṃ*), प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् (*pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvān*), when the rite is completed".

Meaning: O Āditya, the man who, bound to the rite, gives you the food that is the oblation, O Mitra, let that mortal be rich in food and prosper. Protected by you, that man is neither slain nor hindered by anyone, and he is not overcome. Sin does not reach this man who has given you the oblation, whether from near or from afar. शिक्षति (*śikṣati*) is a verb of giving; the parasmaipada is by interchange.

Word-to-word meaning

- आदित्य (*āditya*)—O Āditya
- व्रतेन (*vratena*)—joined to the sacrifice
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- ते (*te*)—to you
- शिक्षति (*śikṣati*)—offers the food in the form of the oblation
- मित्र (*mitra*)—O Mitra
- स मर्तः (*sa martaḥ*)—that man
- प्रयस्वान् (*prayasvān*)—possessed of food
- प्र अस्तु (*pra astu*)—let him be
- त्वोतः (*tvotaḥ*)—the man protected by you
- न हन्यते (*na hanyate*)—is not injured by anyone
- न जीयते (*na jīyate*)—is not conquered by anyone
- एनं (*enaṃ*)—such a sacrificer
- अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*)—sin
- अंतितः (*aṃtitaḥ*)—even near
- न अश्नोति (*na aśnoti*)—does not reach
- दूरात् न (*dūrāt na*)—nor is it far off

Gist

O Āditya, the man bound to the sacrifice who offers you food in the form of the oblation, O Mitra, let that man become rich in food. The man protected by you is not injured by anyone and is not conquered by anyone. Sins do not come near such a sacrificer, nor are they far off.

English translation

May that mortal enjoy abundance, Mitra, who presents you, Aditya, (with offerings) at the sacred rite ; protected by you he is not harmed ; he is not overcome by any one ; sin reaches him not, either from afar or nigh.

Special Topics

At the offering of the oblations called देवसुव (*devasuva*), and at the morning offering when its time has been exceeded, and also when a caru is offered to Mitra, this Ṛk प्र स मित्र (*pra sa mitra*) is to be used as the yājyā mantra. This is stated in the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra by the sūtra प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वांस्तां नष्टवान्महिमाय पृच्छते (*pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvāṃstāṃ naṣṭavānmahimāya pṛcchate*) (Ā. 4-11) and by the sūtra तत इष्टिर्मित्रः सूर्योऽभि यो महिना दिवं प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वानिति संस्थितायां (*tata iṣṭirmitraḥ sūryo 'bhi yo mahinā divaṃ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvāniti saṃsthitāyāṃ*) (Ā. 3-12).

The chief purport of the mantra is that one who worships Āditya, whose nature is Mitra, becomes wholly free of sin and becomes victorious. There is an injunction that this mantra be recited and the offering made at the time of offering oblations to the Devasūs, when the offering is addressed to Mitra, whose nature is truth. One may first learn what the Devasū sacrifice is, and then learn the explanation of the mantra.

देवसुवः (*devasuvaḥ*): this is the name by which the group of gods who give vitality to the whole world is called. The number of these gods is eight. At the time of the abhiṣecanīya rite, a part of the Rājasūya, the prescribed oblation is to be offered to these eight gods. Its order is as follows.

1. सवित्रे सत्यप्रसवाय । द्वादशकपालं वाष्टाकपालं वा पुरोडाशं निर्वपति प्लाशुकानां व्रीहीणां सविता वै देवानां प्रसविता सवितृप्रसूतः सूया इत्यथ यत् प्लाशुकानां व्रीहीणां क्षिप्रे मा प्रसुवानिति ॥ (*savitre satyaprasavāya | dvādaśakapālaṃ vāṣṭākapālaṃ vā puroḍāśaṃ nirvapati plāśukānāṃ vrīhīṇāṃ savitā vai devānāṃ prasavitā savitṛprasūtaḥ sūyā ityatha yat plāśukānāṃ vrīhīṇāṃ kṣipre mā prasuvāniti* ||) (Śa. Brā. 5-3-3-2)

The grain called प्लाशुक (*plāśuka*) gives vitality; it is to give rain quickly. With it an oblation consisting of eight potsherds or of twelve potsherds is to be prepared and offered to Savitṛ, the impeller of the gods and impeller of truth. By thus offering, the king who is ready for the consecration gains confidence of acquiring vigour in his duty.

1. अधाग्नये गृहपतये । अष्टाकपालं पुरोडाशं निर्वपत्याशूनां श्रीर्वै गार्हपत्यं यावतो-यावत ईष्टे तदेनमग्निरेव गृहपतिर्गार्हिपत्यमभिपरिणयत्यथ यदाशूनां क्षिप्रे मा परिणयानिति ॥ (*adhāgnaye gṛhapataye | aṣṭākapālaṃ puroḍāśaṃ nirvapatyāśūnāṃ śrīrvai gārhapatyaṃ yāvato-yāvata īṣṭe tadenamagnireva gṛhapatirgārhapatyamabhipariṇayatyatha yadāśūnāṃ kṣipre mā pariṇayāniti* ‖)

The grain called आशु (*āśu*) is quick to bear fruit. From this grain a puroḍāśa of eight potsherds is to be prepared and offered to Agni, the lord of the house. The position of lord of the house is endowed with wealth. The king who obtains lordship of the house through the grace of such an Agni becomes endowed with wealth. And by offering a puroḍāśa made of आशु (*āśu*) grain, he too, like it, gains quick prosperity.

1. अथ सोमाय वनस्पतॆये । श्यामाकं चरुं निर्वपति तदेनगं् सोम एव वनस्पतिरोषदिभ्यः सुवत्यथ यच्छ्यामाको भवत्येते वै सोमसौषधीनां प्रत्यक्षतमां यच्छ्यामाकास्तस्नाच्छ्यामाको भवति ॥ (*atha somāya vanaspatèye | śyāmākaṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenagṃ soma eva vanaspatiroṣadibhyaḥ suvatyatha yacchyāmāko bhavatyete vai somasauṣadhīnāṃ pratyakṣatamāṃ yacchyāmākāstasnācchyāmāko bhavati* ‖)

King Soma is lord of the plants. Among plants, this श्यामाक (*śyāmāka*) is the dearest to Soma. If a puroḍāśa is prepared from श्यामाक (*śyāmāka*) and offered to Soma, the cause of peace and nourishment, the king who is being consecrated obtains peace and nourishment.

1. अथ बृहस्पतये वाचे । नैवारं चरुं निर्वपति तदेनं बृहस्पतिरेव वाचे सुवत्यथ यन्नेवारो भवति ब्रह्म वै बृहस्पतिरेते वै ब्रह्मणा सच्यंते यन्नीवारास्तस्नान्नीवारो भवति ॥ (*atha bṛhaspataye vāce | naivāraṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenaṃ*

bṛhaspatireva vāce suvatyatha yannèvāro bhavati brahma vai bṛhaspatirete vai brahmaṇā sacyaṃte yannīvārāstasnānnīvāro bhavati ‖)

Bṛhaspati is lord of speech, which is dear to brahman. The नीवार (*nīvāra*) grain is nourished by brahman. Therefore, by preparing a puroḍāśa from this नीवार (*nīvāra*) grain and offering it to Bṛhaspati, the king obtains the grace of Bṛhaspati, lord of speech, and increases his own power of speech.

1. अथेंद्राय ज्येष्ठाय । हायनानां चरुं निर्वपति तदेनमिंद्र एव ज्येष्ठो ज्येष्ठमभिपरिणयत्यथ यद्धायनानां भवत्यतिष्ठा वा एता ओषधयो यद्वायना अतिष्टो वा इंद्रस्तस्माद्दायनानां भवति ॥ (*atheṃdrāya jyeṣṭhāya* | *hāyanānāṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenamiṃdra eva jyeṣṭho jyeṣṭhamabhipariṇayatyatha yaddhāyanānāṃ bhavatyatiṣṭhā vā etā oṣadhayo yadvāyanā atiṣṭo vā iṃdrastasmāddāyanānāṃ bhavati* ‖)[?199]

Among the gods Indra alone is the eldest and the lord. Among plants हायन (*hāyana*) is the eldest. Therefore a caru is to be prepared from हायन (*hāyana*) grain and offered to Indra. Through the grace of this Indra the king, surpassing the foremost position, becomes fit to be lord of all.

1. अथ रुद्राय पशुपतये । रौद्रं गावीधुकं चरुं निर्वपति तदेनग्ं रुद, एव पशुपतिः पशुभ्यः सुवत्यथ यद्दावीधुको भवति वास्तवो वा विष देवो वास्तव्या गावीधुकास्त्स्माद्गावीधुको भवति ॥ (*atha rudrāya paśupataye* | *raudraṃ gāvīdhukaṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenagṃ ruda, eva paśupatiḥ paśubhyaḥ suvatyatha yaddāvīdhuko bhavati vāstavo vā viṣa devo vāstavyā gāvīdhukāstsmādgāvīdhuko bhavati* ‖)

Rudra is lord of animals. गावीधुक (*gāvīdhuka*) grain belongs to Rudra. In the sacrifice the वास्तव्य (*vāstavya*) portion is due to Rudra. गवेधुक (*gavedhuka*)[?200] too must belong to this वास्तव्य (*vāstavya*) group.

Therefore, by offering a caru of गवेधुक (*gavedhuka*) grain to Rudra, lord of animals, there is no doubt that the king obtains wealth of cattle.

1. अथ मित्राय सत्याय ! नांबानां चरुं निर्वपति तदेनं मित्र एव सत्यो ब्रह्मणे सुवत्यथ यन्नांबानां भवति (*atha mitrāya satyāya ! nāṃbānāṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenaṃ mitra eva satyo brahmaṇe suvatyatha yannāṃbānāṃ bhavati*)

Although the नांब (*nāṃba*) seed belongs to Varuṇa, the नांब (*nāṃba*) plant belongs to Mitra. Therefore, if a caru is prepared from नांब (*nāṃba*) seed and offered to Mitra, whose nature is truth and who is the impeller of truth, the king gains Mitra's favour and obtains brahmanical splendour.

1. अथ वरुणाय धर्मपतेये । वारुणं यवमयं चरुं निर्वपति तदेनं वरुण एव धर्मपतिर्धर्मस्य पतिं करोति परमता वै सा यो धर्मस्य पतिरसद्यो हि परमतां गच्छति तगं्हि धर्म उपयंति तस्माद्वरुणाय धर्मपतये (*atha varuṇāya dharmapatèye | vāruṇaṃ yavamayaṃ caruṃ nirvapati tadenaṃ varuṇa eva dharmapatirdharmasya patiṃ karoti paramatā vai sā yo dharmasya patirasadyo hi paramatāṃ gacchati tagṃhi dharma upayaṃti tasmādvaruṇāya dharmapataye*) (Śa. Brā. 5-3-3-9)[?201]

To be lord of dharma and president of dharma is the highest office of a king. For him to obtain this office the favour of Varuṇa, the protector of all dharma in the universe, is absolutely necessary. Therefore a caru is to be prepared from barley, which is dear to him, and offered to him. Through Varuṇa's favour the king obtains the most praiseworthy office of president of dharma.

Thus all eight gods are worshipped, each according to his position, in the rite called Devasū, a part of the Rājasūya. Among them Mitra, whose nature is truth, is one. For his satisfaction the present mantra is recited. The same Devasū sacrifice is stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā also, with slight variation. Differences appear only in a few small points; there is no difference in the explanation of the principal points.

अग्नये गृहपतये पुरोडाशमष्टाकपालं निर्वपति कृष्णानां व्रीहीणाग्ं सोमाय वनस्पतये श्यामाकं चरुग्ं सवित्रे सत्यप्रसवाय पुरोडाशं द्वादशकपालमाशूनां व्रीहीणाग्ं रुद्राय पशुपतये गावीधुकं चरुं बृहस्पतये वाचस्पतये नैवारं चरुमिंद्राय ज्येष्ठाय पुरोडाशमेकादशकपालं महाव्रीहीणां मित्राय सत्यायाम्यानां चरुं वरुणाय धर्मपतये यवमयं चरुग्ं सविता त्वा प्रसवानाग्ं सुवतां ॥
(*agnaye gṛhapataye puroḍāśamaṣṭākapālaṃ nirvapati kṛṣṇānāṃ vrīhīṇāgo somāya vanaspataye śyāmākaṃ carugo savitre satyaprasavāya puroḍāśaṃ dvādaśakapālamāśūnāṃ vrīhīṇāgo rudrāya paśupataye gāvīdhukaṃ caruṃ bṛhaspataye vācaspataye naivāraṃ carumiṃdrāya jyeṣṭhāya puroḍāśamekādaśakapālaṃ mahāvrīhīṇāṃ mitrāya satyāyāmyānāṃ caruṃ varuṇāya dharmapataye yavamayaṃ carugo savitā tvā prasavānāgo suvatāṃ* ||) (Tai. Saṃ. 18-10)

In these mantras the order of the oblations to be offered to the Devasuvas is explained. The number and names of the gods are just as stated in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa. But there is a slightly different account of the grains used for the oblations. For Savitṛ, the impeller of truth, the Śatapatha prescribes the grain called प्लाशुक (*plāśuka*); for Agni, lord of the house, the आशु (*āśu*) grain; for Indra, the eldest, the हायन (*hāyana*) grain. The Taittirīya Saṃhitā specifies the आशु (*āśu*) grain for Savitṛ, black rice for Agni, and large rice for Indra. Although the number of gods is the same, the Śatapatha describes these eight gods in one order. In place of the Śatapatha's बृहस्पतये वाचे (*bṛhaspataye vāce*), the Taittirīya Saṃhitā has बृहस्पतये वाचस्पतये (*bṛhaspataye vācaspataye*).

Thus Mitra, described in the Devasū sacrifice as truth in nature, is praised in this mantra. The man who worships and adores this god is declared to become victorious, possessed of food and free from sin. The same Āditya-principle that was praised as Mitra in the previous mantra is praised in the present one also. This same mantra is recited in the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa also (Tai. Brā. 1-7-4-1). There Sāyaṇa and Bhaṭṭabhāskara have given the explanation of the present Ṛk.

यः ते शिक्षति सः प्रयस्वान् अस्तु (*yaḥ te śikṣati saḥ prayasvān astu*)—Sāyaṇa explains in the Ṛksaṃhitā-bhāṣya that the prayer is: "may he who offers you oblations and the like be rich in food." He has shown that the word शिक्षति (*śikṣati*) has the meaning ददाति (*dadāti*), "gives". Bhaṭṭabhāskara, on the Taittirīya Saṃhitā

[The first lines of this page complete the sentence from the previous page.] In the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, Bhaṭṭabhāskara shows two kinds of construction for the word शिक्षति (*śikṣati*) and states two kinds of purport. First: हे आदित्य आदितेः पुत्र यस्तव प्रीतेन कर्मणा यागादिना शिक्षति शक्तो भवितुमिच्छति....सः न हन्यते....॥ (*he āditya āditeḥ putra yastava prītena karmaṇā yāgādinā śikṣati śakto bhavitumicchati....saḥ na hanyate....*‖) "O Āditya, son of Aditi, whoever gains the power to please you with an action dear to you and to win your favour, he becomes possessed of food": this is one way. Second: शिक्ष-विद्यो पादाने । (*śikṣa-vidyo pādāne* |) वृतेनेति व्यत्ययेन द्वितीयं बहुवचनस्य स्थाने तृतीयैकवचनं । (*vṛteneti vyatyayena dvitīyaṃ bahuvacanasya sthāne tṛtīyaikavacanaṃ* |) The root शिक्ष (*śikṣa*) is used in the sense "acquire learning". Instead of the accusative व्रतानि (*vratāni*) ("vows") the instrumental व्रतेन (*vratena*) is used. The purport, he gives as another way of taking the meaning, is that those who practise the vows again and again and worship Āditya become possessed of food.

But there are many places in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā where the root शिक्ष (*śikṣa*) is used in the sense of giving. For example—

द्युमा असि क्रतुमा इंद्र धीरः शिक्षा शचीवस्तव नः शचेभिः । (*dyumā asi kratumā iṃdra dhīraḥ śikṣā śacīvastava naḥ śacebhiḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-62-12)

Here the sense of giving is stated for शिक्ष (*śikṣa*): "O Indra, possessed of action, give us wealth." Therefore, in the present mantra, the meaning of शिक्षति (*śikṣati*) as "offers the oblation" is not unsound.

अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*)—अंहतिश्चांहश्चांहुश्च हंतेः । (*aṃhatiścāṃhaścāṃhuśca haṃteḥ* |) (Ni. 4-25). Although the word अंहस् (*aṃhas*) is derived from the root हन् (*han*), meaning "to injure", the sense in commonest use for this word is "sin", the source of injury; in the present Ṛk too the meaning is sin.

तोतः (*totaḥ*)—त्वया ऊतः । (*tvayā ūtaḥ* |) "One protected by you": it refers to Āditya. The purport is that for one protected by Āditya, wealth of food, protection from enemies in the form of poverty and the like, and release from sin are all assured.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒न॒मी॒वास॒ इळ॑या॒ मद॑न्तो मि॒तज्ञ॑वो॒ वरि॑म॒न्ना पृ॑थि॒व्याः ।
आ॒दि॒त्यस्य॑ व्र॒तमु॑पक्षि॒यन्तो॑ व॒यं मि॒त्रस्य॑ सुम॒तौ स्या॑म ॥ ३ ॥

> *anamīvāsa iḷayā madanto mitajñavo varimannā pṛthivyāḥ |*
> *ādityasya vratamupakṣiyanto vayaṃ mitrasya sumatau syāma ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अनमीवासः । इळया । मदंतः । मितज्ञवः । वरिमन् । आ । पृथिव्याः ।
> आदित्यस्य । व्रतं । उपक्षियंतः । वयं । मित्रस्य । सुमौ । स्याम ॥ ३ ॥

> *anamīvāsaḥ | iḷayā | madaṃtaḥ | mitajñavaḥ | variman | ā | pṛthivyāḥ |*
> *ādityasya | vrataṃ | upakṣiyaṃtaḥ | vayaṃ | mitrasya | sumau | syāma ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवसुवां हविषु मित्रस्य सत्यस्यानुवाक्या । अनमीवास इळया मदंतः प्र
> स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वानिति सूत्रितं । आ. ४–११ ॥
> हे मित्र अनमीवासो रोगवर्जिता इळयान्नेन मदंतो माद्यंतः पृथिव्या
> वरिमन्विस्तीर्णे प्रदेशे मितज्ञवो मितजानुका आ यथाकामं सर्वत्र गच्छंत
> आदित्यस्य संबंधि व्रतं कर्मोपक्षियंतस्तस्य कर्मणः समीपे निवसंतः । तदीयं
> कर्म कुर्वाणा इत्यर्थः । तादृशा वयं मित्रस्यादित्यस्य सुमत् शोभनायामनुग्रहबुद्ध्यां स्याम ।

> वर्तेमहि ॥ मदंतः । मदी हर्ष इत्यस्य शतरि व्यत्ययेन
> शप् । मितज्ञवः ! जानुशब्दस्य ज्ञुश्कांदसः । वरिमन् । उरुशब्दात्पृथ्वादित्वादिमनिच् ।
> प्रियस्थिरेत्यादिना वरादेशः । सुपां सुलुगिति सप्तम्या लुक् । व्यत्ययेनाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *devasuvāṃ haviṣu mitrasya satyasyānuvākyā | anamīvāsa iḷayā madaṃtaḥ pra*
> *sa mitra marto astu prayasvāniti sūtritaṃ | ā. 4-11 ‖*
> *he mitra anamīvāso rogavarjitā iḷayānnena madaṃto mādyaṃtaḥ pṛthivyā*
> *varimanvistīrṇe pradeśe mitajñavo mitajānukā ā yathākāmaṃ sarvatra gacchaṃta*
> *ādityasya saṃbaṃdhi vrataṃ karmopakṣiyaṃtastasya karmaṇaḥ samīpe nivasaṃtaḥ | tadīyaṃ*
> *karma kurvāṇā ityarthaḥ | tādṛśā vayaṃ mitrasyādityasya sumat*
> *śobhanāyāmanugrahabuddhyāṃ syāma | vartemahi ‖ madaṃtaḥ | madī harṣa ityasya śatari vyatyayena*
> *śap | mitajñavaḥ ! jānuśabdasya jñuśkāṃdasaḥ | variman | uruśabdātpṛthvāditvādimanic | priyasthiretyādinā varādeśaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti saptamyā luk | vyatyayenādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

This is the anuvākyā for Mitra (Satya) in the Devasū oblations; the Āśvalāyana sūtra अनमीवास इळया मदंतः प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् (*anamīvāsa iḷayā madaṃtaḥ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvān*) (Ā. 4-11) prescribes it. "O Mitra, free from disease, rejoicing with इळया (*iḷayā*), food, moving about at will everywhere in the wide expanse of the earth, 'with measured knees' (मितज्ञवः (*mitajñavaḥ*), i.e. मितजानुका (*mitajānukā*)), dwelling near the rite of Āditya, that is, performing his rite, may we be in the good, gracious mind of Mitra, Āditya." The rest is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- अनमीवासः (*anamīvāsaḥ*)—free from disease (O Mitra)
- इळेया (*iḷèyā*)—with food
- मदंतः (*madaṃtaḥ*)—being satisfied
- पृथिव्याः (*pṛthivyāḥ*)—of the earth
- वरिमन् (*variman*)—in the wide region

- मितज्ञवः (*mitajñavaḥ*)—with measured walking
- आ (*ā*) (गच्छंत (*gacchaṃta*))—moving about freely
- आदित्यस्य (*ādityasya*)—directed to Āditya
- व्रतं (*vrataṃ*)—the rite
- उपक्षियंतः (*upakṣiyaṃtaḥ*)—performing
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- मित्रस्य (*mitrasya*)—of Āditya
- सुमत् (*sumat*)—in the gracious mind
- स्याम (*syāma*)—may we be

Gist

O Mitra, may the gracious mind of Āditya rest upon us, who are free from disease, satisfied with food, moving about freely in the wide regions of the earth, and performing the rite directed to Āditya.

English translation

May we, exempt from disease, rejoicing in (abundant) food, roaming free over the wide (expanse) of the earth, diligent in the worship of Aditya, ever be in the good favour of Mitra.

Special Topics

When the oblations called Devasū are offered, this Ṛk अनमीवास इळया (*anamīvāsa iḷayā*) is to be recited as the puronuvākyā mantra addressed to Mitra; this is set out by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra अनमीवास इळया मदंतः प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् (*anamīvāsa iḷayā madaṃtaḥ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvān*) (Ā. 4-11).

In this mantra the favour of Āditya, in the form of Mitra, is prayed for. Neither wealth of food nor wealth of cattle is sought. Even where life is prosperous and contented, the prayer is for good understanding, that one may be a doer of good acts and follow the good path. The epithets अनमीवासः (*anamīvāsaḥ*) and इळेया मदंतः (*iḷèyā madaṃtaḥ*) also show the good state of the worshipper.

On the nature of Iḷā. The word इळया (*iḷayā*) is here explained as "food". The particular deity denoted by the word इळा (*iḷā*) was described earlier, when the deities of the Āprī hymns were treated

[Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, part 11, p. 264]. But the other meanings suggested by this word were not explained there. The uses of this word, which in many contexts give room for doubt, must be examined for what meanings they indicate in which contexts.

The Nirukta author lists the word इळा (*iḷā*) among the names of the earth (Ni. 1-1), among the names of speech (1-11), and among the names of food (2-7). Here it is explained as food. Food may be either earthly wealth of food, or else a particular divine power that is the original cause of this food.

In places such as येषामिळा धृतहस्ता दुरोण आ अपि प्राता निषीदति । (*yeṣāmiḷā dhṛtahastā duroṇa ā api prātā niṣīdati* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-16-8), the goddess in the form of food, characterised as the oblation, अन्नरूपा हविर्लक्षणा देवी निषीदति । (*annarūpā havirlakṣaṇā devī niṣīdati* |): since the goddess in the form of food is described as sitting with butter in her hands, a particular power is indicated. There is room for the doubt whether the goddess Iḷā praised in the Āprī hymns is different from this Iḷā in the form of food; but if all the Śruti passages are examined closely, identity is what appears.

यज्ञे चेद्वै मावकल्पयिष्यसि बहुः प्रजया पशुभिर्भविष्यसि । (*yajñe cedvai māvakalpayiṣyasi bahuḥ prajayā paśubhirbhaviṣyasi* |) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-19)[?202]

This assurance — "if you perform the sacrifice with my help, the sacrificer will be endowed with wealth of food, of cattle and of offspring" — was spoken by the goddess Iḷā. Who is this Iḷā? What is her connection with the sacrifice? These matters are explained in detail in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa. Although, in reality, the Iḷā described in many passages of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā and the Iḷā described in the Śatapatha are the same, particular usages give room for doubt. In some contexts the word इळे (*iḷè*) is used in the masculine; and in places such as इति त्वा देवा इम आहुरैळे .... (*iti tvā devā ima āhuraiḷè* ....) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-95-18), Aila (Purūravas) raises the doubt whether he is a son of Iḷā (fem. इळे (*iḷè*)) or of Iḷa; so there is room for such doubt as well. If the Śruti passages are closely examined, there is no room for such doubts. To know in what context the above-quoted sentence यज्ञे चेद्वै मावकल्पयिष्यसि (*yajñe cedvai* *māvakalpayiṣyasi*) was spoken and what its real meaning is, the story of the Śatapatha must be known. In this narrative the origin, power and nature of Iḷā are fully understood. Thereafter one can understand that the Iḷā praised in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā has this same nature. Moreover, one can examine the appropriateness of the use of इळा (*iḷā*) in the present mantra concerning Mitra.

The origin of Iḷā and her earthly nature.

मनवे ह वै प्रातः .... तदप्येतदुत्तरस्य गिरेर्मनोरवसर्पणमित्यौघो ह ताः सर्वाः प्रजा निरुवाहाधेह मनुरेवैकः परिशिशिषे । (*manave ha vai prātaḥ .... tadapyetaduttarasya girermanoravasarpaṇamityaugho ha tāḥ sarvāḥ prajā niruvāhādheha manurevaikaḥ pariśiśiṣe |*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-1 to 6)

Manu reared a fish in the water brought for washing, and with the help of that fish crossed the great flood, and sat practising austerity at the place famed as Manu's mountain. When the flood had swept away all other creatures and he alone sat there in that tranquil setting practising austerity, the wish for offspring arose in him.

सोऽर्चञ्छ्राम्यंश्चकार प्रजाकामः । तत्रापि पाकयज्ञेनेजे स धृतं दधि मस्त्वामिक्षामित्यप्सु जुहवांचकार ततः संवत्सरे योषित्संबभूव सा ह पिब्बमानेवोदेयाय तस्यै ह स्म धृतं पदे संतिष्ठते तया मित्रावरुणौ संजग्माते ॥ (*so 'rcañcāmyaṃścakāra prajākāmaḥ | tatrāpi pākayajñeneje sa dhṛtaṃ dadhi mastvāmikṣāmityapsu juhavāṃcakāra tataḥ saṃvatsare yoṣitsaṃbabhūva sā ha pibbamānevodeyāya tasyai ha sma dhṛtaṃ pade saṃtiṣṭhate tayā mitrāvaruṇau saṃjagmāte ||*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-7)

Desiring offspring, Manu stayed silent, practising austerity and engaged in worship of the gods. At this time he performed a pāka-yajña and, in the rite belonging to it, offered butter, curds, whey ("Whey" printed) and āmikṣā ("Curds" printed) into the water. Within a year a woman came into being. When she arose, firm of limb (पिब्बमान (*pibbamāna*) = "firm", with limbs), she appeared with butter on her feet.

(The epithet धृतहस्ता (*dhṛtahastā*), 7-16-8, in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā was mentioned above.) At that time Mitra and Varuṇa met her.

तागं्होचतुः कासीति । मनोर्दुहितेत्यावयोर्ब्रूष्टेति नेति होवाच य एव मामजीजनत तस्यैवाहमस्मीति तस्यामपित्वमीषाते तद्वा जज्ञा तद्वा न जज्ञावतित्त्वेवेयाय सा मनुमाजगाम ॥ (*tāgṃhocatuḥ kāsīti | manorduhitetyāvayorbrūṣṭeti neti hovāca ya eva māmajījanata tasyèvāhamasmīti tasyāmapitvamīṣāte tadvā jajñā tadvā na jajñāvatittveveyāya sā manumājagāma ‖*)

When they asked who she was, she said, "I am Manu's daughter." When they pressed, "Say that you are ours," she said, "Certainly not; I belong to him who begot me; I am his daughter." They wished to have a share in her. Then she signified neither consent nor refusal, but went to her father Manu and joined him.

तागं् ह मनुरुवाच कासीति । तव दुहितेति कथं भगवति मम दुहितेति या अमूरस्त्वाहुतीरहौषीर्घृतं दधि मस्तामिक्षां ततो मामजीजनथाः साशीरस्मि तां मा यज्ञेवकल्पय यज्ञे चेद्वै मावकल्पयिष्यसि बहुः प्रजया पशुभिर्भविष्यसि याममुया कां चाशिषमाशासिष्यसे सा ते सर्वा समर्थिष्यत इति तामेशन्मध्ये यज्ञस्यावाकल्पयनमध्यग्ग् हैतद्यक्षस्य यदंतरा प्रयाजानुयाजान् ॥ (*tāgṃ ha manuruvāca kāsīti | tava duhiteti kathaṃ bhagavati mama duhiteti yā amūrastvāhutīrahauṣīrghṛtaṃ dadhi mastāmikṣāṃ tato māmajījanathāḥ sāśīrasmi tāṃ mā yajñevakalpaya yajñe cedvai māvakalpayiṣyasi bahuḥ prajayā paśubhirbhaviṣyasi yāmamuyā kāṃ cāśiṣamāśāsiṣyase sā te sarvā samarthiṣyata iti tāmeśanmadhye yajñasyāvākalpayanamadhyagg haitadyakṣasya yadaṃtarā prayājānuyājān ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-9)

Then Manu too asked who she was. "Your daughter," she said. "O revered one, how are you my daughter?" he said. She replied: "By the oblations of butter, curds, whey and āmikṣā that you offered in the water, in the rite belonging to the pāka-yajña, I was produced; I am a blessing (āśīḥ) for all your undertakings. In sacrificial acts, if you seek my help and perform your rites together with me, you will be possessed of cattle, sons and all wealth. Whatever desires you have, you will obtain them all." On this assurance Manu obtained her help during the sacrificial acts performed in the middle, between the Prayājas and the Anuyājas.

तयर्चञ्चाम्यंश्चचार प्रजाकामः । तयेमां प्रजातिं प्रजज्ञे येयं मनोः प्रजातियाम्वेनया कां चाशिषमाशास्त्र सास्मै सर्वा समार्थ्यत॥ (*tayarcañcāmyaṃścacāra prajākāmaḥ | tayemāṃ prajātiṃ prajajñe yeyaṃ manoḥ prajātiyāmvenayā kāṃ cāśiṣamāśāstra sāsmai sarvā samārthyata‖*)

With her help, worshipping and practising austerity, desiring a son, he remained absorbed in meditation. Through her he created this human progeny. Whatever gracious blessings of hers were to be obtained, he obtained them all and fulfilled his desires.

सैषा निदानेन यदिडा । स यो ह्येवं विद्वानिडया चरत्येतागं् हैव प्रजातिं प्रजायते यां मनुः प्राजायत याम्वेनया कां चाशिषमाशास्त्रे सास्मै सर्वा समृध्यते ॥ (*saiṣā nidānena yadiḍā | sa yo hyevaṃ vidvāniḍayā caratyetāgṃ haiva prajātiṃ prajāyate yāṃ manuḥ prājāyata yāmvenayā kāṃ cāśiṣamāśāstre sāsmai sarvā samṛdhyate ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-11)

This excellent woman is Iḍā in every respect. Whoever, knowing this truth, performs the rite together with Iḍā, increases this human progeny; through her he obtains all blessings and fulfils all his desires. (In इडया चरति (*iḍayā carati*) there are two meanings: one, "with the woman in the form of Iḍā"; the other, "with the pāka-yajña having the nature of Iḍā".)

The sacrificial nature of Iḷā.

Up to here the origin and nature of Iḍā as history have been explained; now the nature of Iḍā in the form of the sacrifice is explained. Iḍā is praised as the animal, Iḍā as food, Iḍā as everything.

सा वै पंचावत्ता भवति । पशवो वा इडा पांक्ता वै पशवः तस्मात्पंचावत्ता भवति । स समवदायेडां । पूर्वार्धं पुरोडाशस्य प्रशीर्य पुरस्ताद्ध्रुवायै निदधाति तागं् होत्रे प्रदाय दक्षिणात्येति ॥ (*sā vai paṃcāvattā bhavati | paśavo vā iḍā pāṃktā vai paśavaḥ tasmātpaṃcāvattā bhavati | sa samavadāyeḍāṃ | pūrvārdhaṃ puroḍāśasya praśīrya purastādbhuvāyai nidadhāti tāgṃ hotre pradāya dakṣiṇātyeti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-12, 13)

Iḍā is of the nature of the animal. The animal has five chief parts; therefore Iḍā too is to be divided into five parts. (By sentences such as यो वै यज्ञं हविष्पंक्तिं वेद हविष्पंकिना यज्ञेन राध्नोति (*yo vai yajñaṃ haviṣpaṃktiṃ veda haviṣpaṃkinā yajñena rādhnoti*) etc., the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa explains these five kinds also, in four or five ways: Ai. Brā. 8-24.) The Adhvaryu divides Iḍā into five portions and places the forward part of the puroḍāśa on the barhis. Then he hands Iḍā to the Hotṛ. The division into five is made by these three acts: upastaraṇa, abhighāraṇa and sviṣṭakṛt.

Having thus stated the procedure belonging to the sacrificial process, the other-worldly power-nature of Iḍā is told next.

The worldly power-nature of Iḷā.

अथोपागं्शूपह्वयेते । एतद्ध वै मनुर्विभयां चकारेदं वै मे कनिष्ठं यज्ञस्य यदियमिडा पाकयज्ञिया यद्वै म इह रक्षाग्सि याज्ञं न (*athopāgṃśūpahvayete | etaddha vai manurvibhayāṃ cakāredaṃ vai me kaniṣṭhaṃ yajñasya yadiyamiḍā pākayajjiyā yadvai ma iha rakṣāgsi yājñaṃ na*)

हन्युरिति तामेतत्पुरा रक्षोभ्यः पुरा रक्षोभ्य इत्येवोपागंशूपाह्वयत तथो एवैनमेष एतत्पुरा .... पह्वयते ॥ (*hanyuriti tāmetatpurā rakṣobhyaḥ purā rakṣobhya ityevopāgaṃśūpāhvayata tatho evainameṣa etatpurā .... pahvayate ‖*)

On this occasion the Hotṛ calls Iḍā in a soft voice. Even so, Manu [thought]: "This act, which is a limb of the sacrifice, is not so firm. Therefore, before the fear of the demons draws near, Iḍā must be protected." Declaring just this wish, he calls her.

स उपह्वयते । उपहूतगं् रथंतरगं् सह पृथिव्योपमां वामदेव्यगं् सहांतरिक्षेण ह्वयतामुपहूतं वामदेव्यगं् सहांतरिक्षेण ह्वयतामुपहूतं बृहत्सह दिवोप मां बृहत्सह दिवा ह्वयतामिति तदेतामेनै तदुपह्वयमान इमांश्च लोकानुपह्वयत एतानि च सामानि ॥ (*sa upahvayate | upahūtagṃ rathaṃtaragṃ saha pṛthivyopamāṃ vāmadevyagṃ sahāṃtarikṣeṇa hvayatāmupahūtaṃ vāmadevyagṃ sahāṃtarikṣeṇa hvayatāmupahūtaṃ bṛhatsaha divopa māṃ bṛhatsaha divā hvayatāmiti tadetāmenai tadupahvayamāna imāṃśca lokānupahvayata etāni ca sāmāni ‖*)

Next he recites the mantras that praise Iḍā. If Iḍā is praised with these mantras, the three worlds beginning with the earth are praised and called for protection. How? By calling the earth together with the Rathantara sāman, the atmosphere together with the Vāmadevya, and the heaven-world together with the Bṛhat, he has called for protection Iḍā herself, who pervades the three worlds. In this way the invocation of the goddess Iḍā, in the form of praise, indicates her special powers.

उपहूता गावः सहर्षभा इति । पशवो वा इडा .... उपहूतेडा ततुरिरिति तदेनां प्रत्यक्षमुपह्वयते ततुरिरिति सर्वग् हैषा पाप्मानं तरति तस्मा दाह ततुरिरिति ॥ (*upahūtā gāvaḥ saharṣabhā iti | paśavo vā iḍā .... upahūteḍā tatuririti tadenāṃ pratyakṣamupahvayate tatuririti sarvag haiṣā pāpmānaṃ tarati tasmā dāha tatuririti ‖*)

The goddess Iḍā herself is of the nature of cattle. She is therefore called with the prayer that she appear together with the bull, and, since Iḍā herself brings about the quieting of all sin, that she come to the sacrifice in a form that gives victory.

उपहूतः सखा भक्ष इति । प्राणा वै सखा भक्षस्तप्राणमुपह्वयतउपहूतगं् हेगिति तच्छरीरमुपह्वयते । (*upahūtaḥ sakhā bhakṣa iti | prāṇā vai sakhā bhakṣastaprāṇamupahvayataupahūtagṃ hegiti taccharīramupahvayate |*) (Śa. Brā. 1.8-1-2)

Iḍā is the dearest friend. Iḍā is the food that is the vital breath. Friend and food are forms of the vital breath and nothing else. The invocation, in the form of a prayer, is made to Iḍā, who is of the nature of the vital breath.

मानवी धृतपदीति । मनुर्ह्येतामग्रेऽजनयत तस्मादाह मानवीति धृतपदीति यदेवास्यै धृतं पदे समतिष्ठत तस्मादाह धृतपदीति ॥ (*mānavī dhṛtapadīti | manurhyetāmagre 'janayata tasmādāha mānavīti dhṛtapadīti yadevāsyai dhṛtaṃ pade samatiṣṭhata tasmādāha dhṛtapadīti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-26)

Thus the goddess Iḍā, described above as of the nature of a cow, bestower of victory, of the nature of food and of the vital breath, is famed as the daughter of Manu. Because ghee clung to her foot, the name Dhṛtapadī also became famous for her.

The spiritual nature of Iḍā.

उत मैत्रावरुणीति । यदेव मित्रावरुणाभ्यागं् समगच्छत स एव मैत्रावरुणो न्यंगो ब्रह्मा देवकृतोपहूतेति ब्रह्मा ह्येषां देवकृतोपहूता दैव्या अध्वरव उपहूता मनुष्या इति तद्दैवांश्चैवाध्वरूनुपह्वयते ये च मानुषा वत्सा वै दैव्याअध्वरवोऽथ य इतरे ते मानुषाः॥ (*uta maitrāvaruṇīti | yadeva mitrāvaruṇābhyāgṃ samagacchata sa eva maitrāvaruṇo nyaṃgo brahmā devakṛtopahūteti brahmā hyeṣāṃ devakṛtopahūtā daivyā adhvarava upahūtā manuṣyā iti taddaivāṃścaivādhvarūnupahvayate ye ca mānuṣā vatsā vai daivyāadhvaravo 'tha ya itare te mānuṣāḥ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-8-1-27)

Iḍā, so described, has shown her relation also to Mitra and Varuṇa. Since, as soon as she was born of Manu, she appeared to Mitra and Varuṇa, she may also be called of the nature of Maitrāvaruṇa. Because she is made by the gods, she is also called Brahma. She is also the Adhvaru connected with the gods. The Adhvarus connected with the gods are like calves to Iḍā, who is of the nature of a cow. All, gods and men alike, obtain food only through Iḍā's favour. That Iḍā is the giver of food and herself of the nature of food. This Iḍā, famed as Maitrāvaruṇī and of the nature of food, is the one indicated in the Ṛk at hand. The meaning is that this food is itself of the nature of Brahma.

The milk of the cow that is Iḍā.

स होवाच । इडैव मे मानव्यग्निहोत्री वायुव्यो वत्सः सजूरुपसृष्टा विराट् संयोजनमाश्विनं दुह्यमानं वैश्वदेवं दुग्धं वायव्यमाह्रियमाणमाग्नेयमधिश्रितमैंद्राग्नमवज्योत्यमानं वारुणमद्भिः प्रत्यानीतं वायव्यमुद्वास्यमानं द्यावापृथिव्यमुद्वासितमाश्विनमुन्नीयमानं वैश्वदेवमुन्नीतं महादेवायोद्यतं वायव्यगं् ह्रियमाणं वैष्णवं निगृहीतः ॥ (*sa hovāca | iḍaiva me mānavyagnihotrī vāyuvyo vatsaḥ sajūrupasṛṣṭā virāṭ saṃyojanamāśvinaṃ duhyamānaṃ vaiśvadevaṃ dugdhaṃ vāyavyamāhriyamāṇamāgneyamadhiśritamaiṃdrāgnamavajyotyamānaṃ vāruṇamadbhiḥ pratyānītaṃ vāyavyamudvāsyamānaṃ dyāvāpṛthivyamudvāsitamāśvinamunnīyamānaṃ vaiśvadevamunnītaṃ mahādevāyodyataṃ vāyavyagṃ hriyamāṇaṃ vaiṣṇavaṃ nigṛhītaḥ ||*) (Śa. Brā. 11-5-3-5)

"Iḍā, daughter of Manu, is my cow of the Agnihotra. The principle of Vāyu is the calf. The relation of the two is Virāj." [Here Sāyaṇa explains: वायुना संश्रितः द्यौः (*vāyunā saṃśritaḥ dyauḥ*), the connection of Vāyu with the atmosphere.] "When the calf joins this cow, after the drinking of the milk, at the time of milking it belongs to the Aśvins; after the milk has been drawn, to the Viśvedevas; when it is brought from the cow-pen, to Vāyu; when it is placed on the fire, to Agni; when it shines, to Indra and Agni; when it is brought out, to Heaven and Earth; at the time of removal, to the Aśvins; when it is raised up, to Mahādeva; when it is made ready for the Āhavanīya, to Viṣṇu." So Uddālaka explained. In such a context one should understand Iḍā to be a special power that propounds a very hidden principle.

The nature of this cow that is Iḍā, the greatness of this milk that is to be offered at the times of the Pāka-yajña and the like, and the wealth of food, in the form of Iḍā, that comes to the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice with her help, are described in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā as follows.

पाकयज्ञं वा अन्वाहिताग्नेः पशव उप तिष्ठंत इडा खलु वै पाकयज्ञस्येषांतरा प्रयाजानूयाजान् यजमानस्य लोकेवहिता तामाह्रियमाणामभि मंत्रयेत सुरूपवर्षवर्ण एहीति पशवो वा इडा पशूनेवोपश्वयते यज्ञं वै देवा अदुह्रन् यज्योऽसुरागं् अदुहत्तेऽसुरा यज्ञदुग्धाः पराभवन् (*pākayajñaṃ vā anvāhitāgneḥ paśava upa tiṣṭhaṃta iḍā khalu vai pākayajñasyèṣāṃtarā prayājānūyājān yajamānasya lokevahitā tāmāhriyamāṇāmabhi maṃtrayeta surūpavarṣavarṇa ehīti paśavo vā iḍā paśūnevopaśvayate yajñaṃ vai devā aduhran yajyo 'surāgṃ aduhatte 'surā yajñadugdhāḥ parābhavan*) (Kṛ. Saṃ. 1-7-1-1)[?203]

Wealth of cattle comes to one who has established the fire for the Pāka-yajña. Iḍā herself is this Pāka-yajña. She is placed between the Prayājas and the Anuyājas. Then one should pray, "O goddess of fair form and of the colour of the rain, be gracious." Since Iḍā is cattle, by this invocation cattle themselves are called. The gods called the sacrifice; the sacrifice called the Asuras. Therefore the Asuras suffered defeat.

यो वै यज्ञस्य दोहं विद्वान् यजतेऽप्यन्यं यजमानं दुहे सा मे सत्याशीरस्य यज्ञस्य भूयादित्याहैष वै यज्ञस्य दोहस्तेनैवैनं दुहे प्रत्ता वै गौर्दुहे प्रत्तेडा यजमानाय दुह एते वा इडाय्के स्तना इडोपहूतेति वायुर्वत्सो यर्हि होतेडामुपह्वयेत तर्हि यजमानो होतारमीक्षमाणो वायुं मनसा ध्यायेत् । (*yo vai yajñasya dohaṃ vidvān yajate 'pyanyaṃ yajamānaṃ duhe sā me satyāśīrasya yajñasya bhūyādityāhaiṣa vai yajñasya dohastenaivainaṃ duhe prattā vai gaurduhe pratteḍā yajamānāya duha ete vā iḍāykè stanā iḍopahūteti vāyurvatso yarhi hoteḍāmupahvayeta tarhi yajamāno hotāramīkṣamāṇo vāyuṃ manasā dhyāyet |*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-7-1-2)

Whoever knows this principle and the way of calling the sacrifice, the sacrifice in the form of Iḍā calls another sacrificer to help him. The sacrificer's reciting, "May the blessing of this sacrifice be fulfilled for me," is itself the milking of the sacrifice. The cow gives her consent to this milking. Since this same prayer is addressed to Iḍā, it is the cow in the form of Iḍā that has been called. [The response इडोपहूता (*iḍopahūtā*) shows the order followed by the gods, and उपहूतेडा (*upahūteḍā*) that of the Asuras. This is a point to be noted in the sacrificial procedure.] Before the worship that calls this cow,

the calf must be joined to the cow. When the sacrificer prays addressing Iḍā, he should look at the Hotṛ's face and meditate on Vāyu.

मात्रे वत्समुपाव सृजति सर्वेण वै यज्ञेन देवास्सुवर्गं लोकमायन्हाकयज्ञेन मनुरश्रामृत्सेडा मनुमुपावर्तत तां देवासुरा व्यह्वयंत प्रतीचीं देवाः पराचीमसुरास्सा देवानुपावर्तत पशवो वै तद्देवानवृणत पशवोऽसुरानजहुर्यं कामयेतापशुस्स्यादिति पराचीं तस्यॆडामुप ह्वयेतापशुरेव भवति ॥ (*mātre vatsamupāva sṛjati sarveṇa vai yajñena devāssuvargaṃ lokamāyanhākayajñena manuraśrāmṛtseḍā manumupāvartata tāṃ devāsurā vyahvayaṃta pratīcīṃ devāḥ parācīmasurāssā devānupāvartata paśavo vai taddevānavṛṇata paśavo 'surānajahuryaṃ kāmayetāpaśussyāditi parācīṃ tasyèḍāmupa dvayetāpaśureva bhavati ||*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-7-1-3)

While meditating on Vāyu he lets the calf go to the cow. It was by the help of this complete sacrifice that the gods obtained heaven. Manu too toiled for this sacrifice. Iḍā went to Manu. When gods and Asuras came to resort to this same Iḍā, the gods called her face to face and the Asuras with face turned away. Iḍā went to the gods and joined them. Therefore the gods obtained wealth of cattle; the Asuras did not obtain it. If a sacrificer wishes that someone remain without cattle, and one calls Iḍā on that man's behalf standing with face turned away, then that sacrificer becomes without cattle.

यं कामयेत पशुमान्त्स्यादिति प्रतीचीं तस्येडामुपह्वयेत पशुमानेव भवति ब्रह्मवादिनो वदंति स त्वा इडामुप ह्वयेत य इडामुपहूयात्मानमिडायामुपह्वयेतेति सा नः प्रिया सुप्रतूर्तिर्मघोनीत्याहेडामेवोपहूयात्मानमिडायमुपह्वयते व्यस्तमिव वा एतद्यज्ञस्य यदिडा सामि प्राश्नंति ॥ (*yaṃ kāmayeta paśumāntsyāditi pratīcīṃ tasyeḍāmupahvayeta paśumāneva bhavati brahmavādino vadaṃti sa* *tvā iḍāmupa hvayeta ya iḍāmupahūyātmānamiḍāyāmupahvayetèti sā naḥ priyā supratūrtirmaghonītyāheḍāmevopahūyātmānamiḍāyamupahvayate vyastamiva vā etadyajñasya yadiḍā sāmi prāśnaṃti* ‖) (Kṛ. Saṃ. 1-7-1-4)[?204]

If the sacrificer is to obtain wealth of cattle, one must stand face to face and call Iḍā with prayer on his behalf. At once that sacrificer obtains wealth of cattle. When calling Iḍā with prayer, the praiser sees unity between himself and Iḍā; the knowers of the principle say that he has made his own nature one with Iḍā. He prays: "May Iḍā be for my share the doer of what is dear, the giver of victory, and the giver of abundant wealth." Iḍā is, as it were, somewhat broken in the middle of the sacrifice. By saying that in it the meaning is enjoyed, and so on, her protective nature and her power to break the Asuras and others are described. And Iḍā's capacity to protect the world is explained still more fully.

सग्ग श्रवा ह सौवर्चनसस्तु मिंजमौपोदितिमुवाच यत्सत्रिणागं्होता भूः कामिडामुपाह्वथा इति तामुपाह्व इति होवाचे या प्राणेन देवान्हा- धार व्यानेन मनुष्यानपानेन पितृनिति छिनत्ती सा न छिनत्ती ३ इति छिनत्तीति होवाच शरीरं वा अस्यै तदुपाह्वथा इति होवाच गौर्वै अस्यै शरीरं। (*sagga śravā ha sauvarcanasastu miṃjamaupoditimuvāca yatsatriṇāgṃhotā bhūḥ kāmiḍāmupāhvathā iti tāmupāhva iti hovācè yā prāṇena devānhā- dhāra vyānena manuṣyānapānena pitṛniti chinattī sā na chinattī 3 iti chinattīti hovāca śarīraṃ vā asyai tadupāhvathā iti hovāca gaurvai asyai śarīraṃ*|) (Śai. Saṃ. 1-7-2-1)[?205]

Saṃśravas, son of Suvarcanas, asked Tumiñja Aupoditi: "When were you Hotṛ to those who perform a sattra sacrifice? In which form of Iḍā did you pray, praising her?" Aupoditi answered: "I prayed to that Iḍā who sustains the gods with the prāṇa breath, men with the vyāna breath, and the fathers with the apāna breath." To the question whether she is one who divides or one who does not divide, he answered that she is one who divides. "Then did you praise her body?" he asked. The body of that Iḍā is the cow.

गां वाव तौ तत्परवदतां या यज्ञे दीयते सा प्राणेन देवान्दाधार यया मनुष्या जीवंति सा व्यानेन मनुष्यान् यां पितृभ्यो घ्निंति सापानेन पित्र्यन् य एवं वेद पशुमान्भवत्यथ वै तामुपाह्व इति होवाच या प्रजाः प्रभवंतीः प्रत्याभवतीति ॥ (*gāṃ vāva tau tatparavadatāṃ yā yajñe dīyate sā prāṇena devāndādhāra yayā manuṣyā jīvaṃti sā vyānena manuṣyān yāṃ pitṛbhyo ghniṃti sāpānena pitryan ya evaṃ veda paśumānbhavatyatha vai tāmupāhva iti hovāca yā prajāḥ prabhavaṃtīḥ pratyābhavatīti* ‖) (Kṛ. Saṃ. 1-7-2-2)[?206]

The two of them, eager to know the meaning of the principle, were discussing that cow in the form of Iḍā. This Iḍā, offered for the sake of the sacrifice, sustains the gods in the form of prāṇa. She by whose support men live, those men she sustains with vyāna and is the cause of their growth; the fathers, for whose sake they slay her, she sustains with apāna. He who knows all these principles is possessed of wealth of cattle. Aupoditi answered: "I have prayed to that Iḍā who is the cause of the increase of creatures."

अन्नं वा अस्यैतदुपाह्वथा इति होवाचौषधयो वा अन्या अन्नमौपधयो वै प्रजाः प्रभवंतीः प्रत्या भवंति य एवं वेदान्नादो भवत्यथ वै तामुपाह्व इति होवाच या प्रजाः पराभवंतीरनुगृह्णांति प्रता,भवंतीर्गृह्णांतीति प्रतिष्ठां वा अस्यै तदुपाह्वथा इति होवाच ॥ (*annaṃ vā asyaitadupāhvathā iti hovācauṣadhayo vā anyā annamaupadhayo vai prajāḥ prabhavaṃtīḥ pratyā bhavaṃti ya evaṃ vedānnādo bhavatyatha vai tāmupāhva iti hovāca yā prajāḥ parābhavaṃtīranugṛhṇāṃti pratā,bhavaṃtīrgṛhṇāṃtīti pratiṣṭhāṃ vā asyai tadupāhvathā iti hovāca* ‖) (Kṛ. Saṃ. 1-7 2 3)[?207]

Then it amounts to praying for Iḍā's food. This food is itself in the form of herbs. If creatures prosper, they obtain these herbs that are of the nature of food. When Saṃśravas said that one who knows this principle eats food, Aupoditi said again: "I have prayed to Iḍā, who lifts up those fallen into misfortune and shows favour to them when they prosper." He replied that then he has obtained her complete support.

इयं ना अस्यॆ प्रतिष्ठेयं वै प्रजाः पराभवंतीरनु गृह्णाति प्रत्याभवंतीर्गृह्णातिय एवं वेद प्रत्येक तिष्ठत्यथ वै तामुपाह्व इति होवाच यस्यॆ निक्रमणे धृतं प्रजास्संजीवंतीः पिबंति त्रि छिनत्ति सा न छिनत्ती ३ इति न छिनत्तीति होवाच प्र तु जनयतीत्येष वा इडामुपाह्वथा इति होवाच वृष्टिर्वा इडा वृष्टैः वै निक्रमणे धृतं प्रजास्संजीवंतीः पिबंति य एवं वेद प्रैव जायतेऽन्नादो भवति॥ (*iyaṃ nā* *asyè pratiṣṭheyaṃ vai prajāḥ parābhavaṃtīranu gṛhṇāti pratyābhavaṃtīrgṛhṇātiya evaṃ veda pratyeka tiṣṭhatyatha vai tāmupāhva iti hovāca yasyè nikramaṇe dhṛtaṃ prajāssaṃjīvaṃtīḥ pibaṃti tri chinatti sā na chinattī 3 iti na chinattīti hovāca pra tu janayatītyeṣa vā iḍāmupāhvathā iti hovāca vṛṣṭirvā iḍā vṛṣṭaiḥ vai nikramaṇe dhṛtaṃ prajāssaṃjīvaṃtīḥ pibaṃti ya evaṃ veda praiva jāyate 'nnādo bhavati‖*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-7-2-4)

This earth, the support of all and of the nature of Iḍā, is the one who lifts up those fallen into misfortune and favours those who are to grow. He who knows this principle obtains a complete and firm support for his existence and growth. When again he was asked whether this Iḍā is one who divides or one who does not, whether she is a divider or not, he said: she does not divide, but becomes the cause of increase. This Iḍā of great power is the rain. Relying on this rain, creatures drink ghee, the support of their life. For this satisfaction Iḍā, Dhṛtapadī, is the cause. The praiser who relies on her obtains all wealth and wealth of progeny: so is the greatness of Iḍā described. In the explanations above she is praised as a goddess pervading the universe; as the giver of support to gods, men and all; as the earth, support of all; as the giver of satisfaction to all worlds in the form of food; as the friend in distress; as having power to punish the wicked and protect the good; and as the very form of rain, the support of the life of the world. Ghee, the support of the world's life, is what is to be obtained through her favour. The Iḷā whom the Ṛk Saṃhitā praises as धृतहस्ता (*dhṛtahastā*) is praised in the Śatapatha and other texts as धृतपदी (*dhṛtapadī*). In the Ṛk at hand, which praises Mitra, Iḷā in the form of food is indicated, and the relation between Mitra and Iḷā is told. That she is of the nature of Maitrāvaruṇa has been stated above and its meaning explained. Since in the Ṛk at hand the word इळा (*iḷā*) is taken to mean food, only one aspect of Iḷā's nature is set forth.

अनमीवासः (*anamīvāsaḥ*)—the word अमीव (*amīva*) is formed from the word अम (*ama*), which gives the sense of disease (अम रोगे (*ama roge*)). अनमीवासः (*anamīvāsaḥ*) shows its negation: it means "free from disease". The word अमीव (*amīva*) is also used in the sense of "enemy". अमीवहन् (*amīvahan*) is an epithet of Indra and others, meaning "destroyer of enemies".

उपक्षियंतः (*upakṣiyaṃtaḥ*)—when the preverb उप (*upa*) joins the root क्षि (*kṣi*), the meaning is "dwell nearby". The word is used in this sense on many occasions. For example,

Likewise in यस्य ते अग्ने अन्ये अग्नय उपक्षितो वया इव । (*yasya te agne anye agnaya upakṣito vayā iva* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-19-33), the word उपक्षितः (*upakṣitaḥ*) is used to convey that the other fires also dwell near the chief Agni. In the present Ṛk too that meaning is natural; yet the purport is that one stays near Agni and carries out the sacrificial rite.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं मि॒त्रो न॑म॒स्य॑ः सु॒शेवो॒ राजा॑ सु॒क्ष॒त्रो अ॑जनिष्ट वे॒धाः ।
तस्य॑ व॒यं सु॑म॒तौ य॒ज्ञिय॒स्यापि॑ भ॒द्रे सौ॑मन॒से स्या॑म ॥ ४ ॥

> *ayaṃ mitro namasyaḥ suśevo rājā sukṣatro ajaniṣṭa vedhāḥ |*
> *tasya vayaṃ sumatau yajñiyasyāpi bhadre saumanase syāma ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । मित्रः । नमस्यः । सुशेवः राजा । सुक्षत्रः । अजनिष्ट । वेधाः ।
> तस्य । वयं । सुमतौ । यज्ञियस्य । अपि । भद्रे । सौमनसे । स्याम ॥ ४ ॥

> *ayaṃ | mitraḥ | namasyaḥ | suśevaḥ rājā | sukṣatraḥ | ajaniṣṭa | vedhāḥ |*
> *tasya | vayaṃ | sumatau | yajñiyasya | api | bhadre | saumanase | syāma ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अयं पूर्वमंत्रे प्रतिपादितो मित्रः सूर्यो नमस्यः सर्वर्नमस्करणीयः सुशेवः शोभनसुखः । सुखेन सेव्य इत्यर्थः । राजा सर्वस्य जगतः प्रकाशप्रदानेन स्वामी सुक्षत्रः । क्षत्रशब्देन बलमुच्यते । शोभनबलोपेतो वेधाः
> सर्वस्य जगतो विधाता । एवंगुणोपेतः सूर्योऽजनिष्ट । प्रादुरभूत् । तस्यैवंविधगुणोपेतस्य यज्ञियस्य यज्ञार्हस्य सूरस्य सुमतौ शोभनायां बुद्ध्यां
> भद्रे कल्याणकारिणि सौमनसे सौमनस्येॆपि यजमाना वयं स्याम । भवेम ॥
> नमस्यः नमसि साधुः । तत्र साधुरिति यत् । तित्स्वरितः । अजनिष्ट । जनी प्रादुर्भाव
> इत्यस्य लुजि सिचि रूपं । सौमनसे । सुमनस इदमित्यर्थे तस्येदमित्यण् । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *ayaṃ pūrvamaṃtre pratipādito mitraḥ sūryo namasyaḥ sarvarnamaskaraṇīyaḥ suśevaḥ śobhanasukhaḥ | sukhena sevya ityarthaḥ | rājā sarvasya jagataḥ prakāśapradānena svāmī sukṣatraḥ | kṣatraśabdena balamucyate | śobhanabalopeto vedhāḥ*
> *sarvasya jagato vidhātā | evaṃguṇopetaḥ sūryo 'janiṣṭa | prādurabhūt | tasyaivaṃvidhaguṇopetasya yajñiyasya yajñārhasya sūrasya sumatau śobhanāyāṃ buddhyāṃ*
> *bhadre kalyāṇakāriṇi saumanase saumanasyèpi yajamānā vayaṃ syāma | bhavema ‖*
> *namasyaḥ namasi sādhuḥ | tatra sādhuriti yat | titsvaritaḥ | ajaniṣṭa | janī prādurbhāva*
> *ityasya luji sici rūpaṃ | saumanase | sumanasa idamityarthe tasyedamityaṇ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

This Mitra, the Sun set forth in the previous mantra, is नमस्यः (*namasyaḥ*), to be bowed to by all; सुशेवः (*suśevaḥ*), one of good happiness, that is, easily served; राजा (*rājā*), lord of the whole world through giving light; सुक्षत्रः (*sukṣatraḥ*), for the word क्षत्र (*kṣatra*) denotes strength, so one endowed with good strength; वेधाः (*vedhāḥ*), the ordainer of the whole world. The Sun, endowed with such qualities, has been born, that is, has appeared. May we, the sacrificers, be in the good intention (सुमतौ (*sumatau*)) and the auspicious, welfare-bringing benevolence (सौमनसे (*saumanase*)) of that Sun, who is so endowed and worthy of sacrifice.?208

Word-to-word meaning

- अयं मित्रः (*ayaṃ mitraḥ*)—this Mitra who is praised here
- नमस्यः (*namasyaḥ*)—worthy of worship
- सुशेवः (*suśevaḥ*)—served with ease
- राजा (*rājā*)—lord of the whole world
- सुक्षेत्रः (*sukṣetraḥ*)—possessed of excellent strength
- वेधाः (*vedhāḥ*)—creator of the world
- अजनिष्ट (*ajaniṣṭa*)—has been born
- तस्य (*tasya*)—of such a
- यज्ञियस्य (*yajñiyasya*)—Mitra (the Sun), worthy of worship
- सुमतौ (*sumatau*)—in the mind that is gracious
- भद्रे (*bhadre*)—and auspicious
- सौमनसे (*saumanase*)—and beneficial
- अपि वयं (*api vayaṃ*)—we, the sacrificers
- स्याम (*syāma*)—may we be

Gist

Here the Mitra who is praised has been born worshipful, served with ease, lord of the whole world, possessed of excellent strength and creator of the world. May we sacrificers be in the gracious and auspicious mind of this worshipful Sun.

English translation

This Mitra has been engendered adorable and to be served, the sovereign (over all), endowed with vigour, the creator (of the universe); may we ever be in the good favour, in the auspicious approbation, of this adorable (Aditya).

Special Topics

In this mantra addressed to Mitra, the two epithets राजा (*rājā*) and सुक्षेत्रः (*sukṣetraḥ*) show Mitra's qualities. When divine power is described as of two kinds, Brahma and Kṣatra, the Śruti passages praise Mitra as the deity signifying the Brahma-power and Varuṇa as the deity signifying the Kṣatra-power.

क्रतुदक्षौ ह वाअस्य मित्रावरुण् .... स दक्षो मित्र एव क्रतुर्वरुणो दक्षो ब्रह्मैव मित्रः क्षत्रं वरुणोऽभिगंतैव ब्रह्म कर्ता क्षत्रियः ॥ (*kratudakṣau ha vāasya mitrāvaruṇ .... sa dakṣo mitra eva kraturvaruṇo dakṣo brahmaiva mitraḥ kṣatraṃ varuṇo 'bhigaṃtaiva brahma kartā kṣatriyaḥ ||*) (Śa. Brā. 4-1-4-1)

Mitra is of the nature of the power of will (resolve); Varuṇa is of the nature of the power of action. Mitra is of the nature of Brahma, Varuṇa of Kṣatra; Brahma holds the will in the form of resolve, and Kṣatra the power that brings that resolve into the form of action: thus the relation and the difference between Brahma and Kṣatra are shown. This being so, the question arises how the epithet सुक्षत्रः (***sukṣatraḥ***) in the present Ṛk fits Mitra. But Sāyaṇa has said that here the word क्षत्र (***kṣatra***) means strength, and that the epithet राजा (***rājā***) means the self-luminous one who illumines the world, of the form of light.

But the word क्षत्र (*kṣatra*) does not mean merely physical power. Since it is joined here with the other epithets, it shows Mitra's extraordinary qualities. Mitra here means Āditya, who is of the nature of Mitra.

दैवं क्षत्रं याचेदित्याहुरादित्यो वै दैवं क्षत्रमादित्य एषां भूतनामधिपतिः ॥ (*daivaṃ kṣatraṃ yācedityāhurādityo vai daivaṃ kṣatramāditya eṣāṃ bhūtanāmadhipatiḥ ||*) (Ai. Brā. 7-20)

This Āditya, the eye of the world, is the very essence of Kṣatra. By meditating on this greatness the sacrificer, through the protection of the Kṣatra-form power of Āditya, himself attains lordship: thus the nature of Āditya is praised. This power of Kṣatra has also the power to protect Brahma.

क्षत्रं तदपि विजेयं ब्रह्म यत्पाति शाश्वतं (*kṣatraṃ tadapi vijeyaṃ brahma yatpāti śāśvataṃ*) (Bṛ. De. 5-126)

That which has the power to protect the eternal Brahma is renowned as Kṣatra. By this great power all other powers must be protected.

तस्माक्षत्रात्परं नास्ति तस्माद्ब्राह्मणः क्षत्रियमधस्तात् उपास्ते । (*tasmākṣatrātparaṃ nāsti tasmādbrāhmaṇaḥ kṣatriyamadhastāt upāste |*) (Bṛ. U. 1-4-11)

That is why, in the Rājasūya and the like, even the Brāhmaṇa sits at a lower place than the Kṣatriya. This is divine power.

तच्छैयोरूपमत्यसृजत धर्मं तदेतत् क्षत्रस्य क्षत्रं यद्धर्मस्तस्माद्धर्मात्परं ।
(*tacchaiyorūpamatyasrjata dharmaṃ tadetat kṣatrasya kṣatraṃ yaddharmastasmāddharmātparaṃ* |) (Bṛ. U. 1-4-24)

This Kṣatra-power is itself the regulation of the universe. Since it is the very law (dharma) of the universe, one who has obtained its protection, though weak, may obtain protection equal to that of the strong. This Kṣatra is of the nature of truth. What is Kṣatra is Dharma; what is Dharma is Kṣatra. Therefore this Kṣatra, the cause of the welfare of the world, is described as Āditya's power of regulating the universe, as productive of welfare, and as the upholder of right conduct. It is because of the great regard for moral conduct that in the present mantra, with भद्रे सौमनसे स्याम (*bhadre saumanase syāma*), the pure mind needed for excellent conduct is desired and prayed for. Therefore, whenever the word क्षत्र (*kṣatra*) stands as an epithet of the word मित्र (*mitra*), this purport is to be stated.

मित्रः क्षत्रं क्षत्रपतिः । क्षत्रमस्मिन्यज्ञे मयि दधातु । (*mitraḥ kṣatraṃ kṣatrapatiḥ* | *kṣatramasminyajñe mayi dadhātu* |) (Śa. Brā. 11-4-3-10)

In all such sentences too, Mitra is called lord of Kṣatra in this sense. Because he illumines the world, the epithet राजा (*rājā*) also occurs. This epithet shows the world-lordship of Āditya, who is of the form of Mitra.

असावादित्य एकविग्ंशस्तद्दैवं क्षत्रग्ं सा श्रीस्तदाधिपत्यं तद्ब्रध्नस्य विष्टपं तत्स्वाराज्यमश्नुते ॥
(*asāvāditya ekavigṃśastaddaivaṃ kṣatragṃ sā śrīstadādhipatyaṃ tadbradhnasya viṣṭapaṃ tatsvārājyamaśnute* ||) (Śa. Brā. 13-1-7-3)

This divine lord shining in the atmosphere is the power in the form of Kṣatra. By worshipping this Āditya, of the form of radiance, who illumines the world and brings welfare to it, a radiant sovereignty of one's own is obtained. This nature of Āditya, thus described, is described also in the present Ṛk, and the benevolence and the auspicious good mind to be gained through his grace are prayed for.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हाँ आ॑दि॒त्यो नम॑सोप॒सद्यो॑ यात॒यज्ज॑नो गृ॒णते सु॒शेव॑ः ।
तस्मा॑ ए॒तत्पन्य॑तमाय॒ जुष्ट॑म॒ग्नौ मि॒त्राय॑ ह॒विरा जु॑होत ॥ ५ ॥

> *mahā~ ādityo namasopasadyo yātayajjano gṛṇate suśevaḥ |*
> *tasmā etatpanyatamāya juṣṭamagnau mitrāya havirā juhota ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महान् । आदित्यः । नमसा । उपसद्यः । यातयत्जनः । गृणते । सुशेवः ।
> तस्मै । एतत् । पन्यतमाय । जुष्टं । अग्नौ । मित्राय । हविः । आ । जुहोत ॥ ५ ॥

> *mahān | ādityaḥ | namasā | upasadyaḥ | yātayatjanaḥ | gṛṇate | suśevaḥ |*
> *tasmai | etat | panyatamāya | juṣṭaṃ | agnau | mitrāya | haviḥ | ā | juhota ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> योऽयमादित्यो महान् अत एव नमसा नमस्कारेणोपसद्यः सर्वैरुपसदनीयो यातयज्जनः । प्रातः प्रातः स्वस्वकर्मणि प्रवर्तनीया जना येनेति स
> तथोक्तः । गृणते स्तोत्रं कुर्वते जनाय सुशेवश्च भवति तस्मै पन्यतमाय स्तुत्यतमाय मित्रायादित्याय जुष्टं प्रीतिविषयमेतद्धविरग्नावा जुहोत । जुहुत ॥
> यातयज्जनः । यती प्रयत्न इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य शतरि रूपं । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपद–

> *yo 'yamādityo mahān ata eva namasā namaskāreṇopasadyaḥ sarvairupasadanīyo yātayajjanaḥ | prātaḥ prātaḥ svasvakarmaṇi pravartanīyā janā yeneti sa*
> *tathoktaḥ | gṛṇate stotraṃ kurvate janāya suśevaśca bhavati tasmai panyatamāya stutyatamāya mitrāyādityāya juṣṭaṃ*

> *prītiviṣayametaddhaviragnāvā juhota | juhuta ‖*
> *yātayajjanaḥ | yatī prayatna ityasya ṇyaṃtasya śatari rūpaṃ |*
> *bahuvrīhau pūrvapada-*

> प्रकृतिस्वरे प्राप्ते मरुद्वृद्धादित्वात्पूर्वपदांतोदात्तत्वं । गृणते । ग्य शब्दे ।
> शतुरनुम इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । पन्यतमाय । पनतेरघ्न्यादित्वाद्यत् । यतोऽनाव
> इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं । जुष्टं । नित्यं मंत्र इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *prakṛtisvare prāpte marudvṛddhāditvātpūrvapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ |*
> *gṛṇate | gya śabde |*
> *śaturanuma iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | panyatamāya |*
> *panateraghnyāditvādyat | yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ | juṣṭaṃ |*
> *nityaṃ maṃtra ityādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

This Āditya is great, and therefore नमसा उपसद्यः (*namasā upasadyaḥ*), to be approached by all with homage. He is यातयज्जनः (*yātayajjanaḥ*): he by whom people are set, morning after morning, to their respective works. He is सुशेवः (*suśevaḥ*), a giver of happiness, to the man who praises him. To that most praiseworthy (पन्यतमाय (*panyatamāya*), स्तुत्यतमाय (*stutyatamāya*)) Mitra, the Āditya, offer (आ जुहोत (*ā juhota*), that is जुहुत (*juhuta*)) this oblation, the object of his delight (जुष्टं (*juṣṭaṃ*)), in the fire. The block then begins the grammatical remarks on यातयज्जनः (*yātayajjanaḥ*).

The block consists only of grammatical remarks (formation and accent of यातयज्जनः (*yātayajjanaḥ*), गृणते (*gṛṇate*), पन्यतमाय (*panyatamāya*), जुष्टं (*juṣṭaṃ*)); it adds nothing to the sense.

Word-to-word meaning

- आदित्यः (*ādityaḥ*)—Āditya
- महान् (*mahān*)—being of great nature
- नमसा (*namasā*)—with homage
- उपसन्नः (*upasannaḥ*)—one who is approached?[209]
- यातयज्जनः (*yātayajjanaḥ*)—one who impels people to their respective works
- गृणते (*gṛṇate*)—to the sacrificer who praises

- सुशेवः (*suśevaḥ*)—and a giver of happiness
- पन्यतमाय (*panyatamāya*)—most praiseworthy
- मित्रायॆ (*mitrāyè*)—and of the form of Mitra[?210]
- तस्यै (*tasyai*)—addressed to that Āditya[?211]
- जुष्टं (*juṣṭaṃ*)—fit to be enjoyed with love
- एतत् हविः (*etat haviḥ*)—this oblation
- अग्नौ (*agnau*)—in the fire
- आ जुहोत (*ā juhota*)—offer as an oblation

Gist

Āditya is of great nature, approached with homage, the impeller of people to their respective works, and a giver of happiness to the sacrificer who praises him. To this Āditya, most praiseworthy and of the form of Mitra, offer in the fire, as an oblation, this offering fit to be enjoyed with love.

English translation

The great Aditya, the animator of men to exertion, is to be approached with reverenee : he is the giver of happiness to him who praises him : offer with fire the acceptable libation to that most glorifiable Mitra.

Special Topics

On the fifth day of the sacrifice called Abhiplava, when the Vaiśvadeva-śastra mantras are recited, the three Ṛks of this sūkta beginning इंद्र ऋभुभिः (*iṃdra ṛbhubhiḥ*) are to be recited as a tṛca addressed to the Ṛbhus. This is set out in Āśvalāyana's Śrauta-sūtra by the sūtra धृतवती भुवनानामभिश्रियेंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिरिति तेचौ (*dhṛtavatī bhuvanānāmabhiśriyeṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavaddhiriti tècau*) (Ā. 7 7). And the first Ṛk of this sūkta is to be recited by the Hotṛ at the third pressing as the prasthita-yājyā mantra; this is set out by the Āśvalāyana sūtra इंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिः समुक्षितमिंद्रावरुणा सुतपाविमं सुतं (*iṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavaddhiḥ samukṣitamiṃdrāvaruṇā sutapāvimaṃ sutaṃ*) (Ā. 5-5).

In this Ṛk the worshipfulness of Āditya, the impeller of the world, is praised. That is why he is described by the epithet पन्यतमाय (*panyatamāya*).

पन्यतमाय (*panyatamāya*)—स्तुत्यतमाय (*stutyatamāya*): to Āditya, who is the most excellent among those worthy of praise and who is of the form of Mitra. The words पनस्यति (*panasyati*) and पनायते (*panāyate*) are read among the names of the act of worship (Ni. 3-19). With examples such as अभीशूनां महिमानं पनायत (*abhīśūnām mahimānam panāyata*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-75-6), the purport of the words पनितारः (*panitāraḥ*), विपस्यवः (*vipasyavaḥ*) and the like was explained earlier; they are words expressing worshipfulness. In the present place too it indicates the worshipfulness of Āditya.

सुशेवः (*suśevaḥ*)—The word शेव (*śeva*) is read among the names of happiness (Ni. 3-6). It is used in the senses of "the object of love", "what produces happiness" and the like.

न हि ग्रभायमाणः सुशेवोऽन्योदर्यः (*na hi grabhāyamāṇaḥ suśevo 'nyodaryaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-4-8): in this sentence, which means that one born of another's womb, though सुशेव (*suśeva*), is not fit to be accepted, the meaning is "the giver of delight".

प्रति मे स्तोममदितिर्जगृभ्यात् सूनुं न माता हृद्यं सुशेवं (*prati me stomamaditirjagṛbhyāt sūnuṃ na mātā hṛdyaṃ suśevaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-42-2)

उपसर्प मातरं भूमिमेतामुरुव्यचसं पृथिवीं सुशेवां (*upasarpa mātaraṃ bhūmimetāmuruvyacasaṃ pṛthivīṃ suśevāṃ*) (10-18-10)

In such places it is used in the sense of "very dear". Of these, in the first example, where it is said that as a mother embraces her son who is सुशेव (*suśeva*), the relation of mother and son is shown; in the second, where it speaks of the earth who is सुशेवा (*suśevā*), since the epithet मातरं (*mātaraṃ*) is present, the relation between sons and the mother is shown. This epithet occurs in describing things that are pleasing, charming and productive of delight. Its use may also be seen where the negation of these is to be shown. For example, in अत्रा जहाम ये असन्नशेवाः (*atrā jahāma ye asannaśevāḥ*) (10-53-8), "we leave behind here all those who are not wanted by us", the word अशेव (*aśeva*) comes to mean "not to be regarded".

व्येतु विद्युद्विषामशेवा युयोत विष्णुग्रपस्तनूनां (*vyetu vidyudviṣāmaśevā yuyota viṣṇugrapastanūnāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-34-13)

Here, "may this weapon of the enemies, or this poverty, harmful like a weapon, being अशेव (*aśeva*), be far from us, that is, be destroyed": the word अशेव (*aśeva*) has the sense "not productive of happiness, harmful". Thus there are uses of the words सुशेव (*suśeva*) and अशेव (*aśeva*).

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मि॒त्रस्य॑ चर्षणी॒धृतोऽवो॑ दे॒वस्य॑ सान॒सि ।
द्यु॒म्नं चि॒त्रश्र॑वस्तमम् ॥ ६ ॥

> *mitrasya carṣaṇīdhṛto 'vo devasya sānasi |*
> *dyumnaṃ citraśravastamam ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मित्रस्य । चर्षणिधृतः । अवः । देवस्य । सानसि ।
> द्युम्नं । चित्रश्रवतमं ॥ ६ ॥

> *mitrasya | carṣaṇidhṛtaḥ | avaḥ | devasya | sānasi |*
> *dyumnaṃ | citraśravatamaṃ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अभिप्लवषडहे दशरात्रे च सप्तदशैकविंशादिस्तोमे सति होत्रादिकशस्त्रेष्वावापस्थाने पंचसप्तादिसंख्याका ऋच आवपनीयाः । तत्र मैत्रावरुणशस्त्रे मित्रस्य चर्षन्णीधृत इत्याद्याश्चतस्र आवापार्थाः । सूत्रितं च । मित्रस्य चर्षन्णीधृत इति चितस्रो मैत्र्यः । आ. ७–५ । इति ॥
> चर्षणीधृतो मनुष्याणां वृष्टिप्रदानेन धारकस्य मित्रस्य देवस्य संजंध्यवोऽन्नं सानसि सर्वैः संभजनीयं द्युम्नं तदीयं धनं च चित्रश्रवस्तमं । अतिशयेन चायनीयकीर्तियुक्तं ॥ सानसि । सनोतेः सानसिपर्णसीत्यादिनासिच् प्रत्ययांतत्वेन निपातनादुपधावृद्धिः । चित्तादंतोदात्तः । स्वमोरिति स्वमोर्लुक् ॥

> *abhiplavaṣaḍahe daśarātre ca saptadaśaikaviṃśādistome sati hotrādikaśastreṣvāvāpasthāne paṃcasaptādisaṃkhyākā ṛca āvapanīyāḥ | tatra maitrāvaruṇaśastre mitrasya carṣannṇīdhṛta ityādyāścatasra āvāpārthāḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | mitrasya carṣannṇīdhṛta iti citasro maitryaḥ | ā. 7-5 | iti ‖ carṣaṇīdhṛto manuṣyāṇāṃ vṛṣṭipradānena dhārakasya mitrasya devasya saṃjaṃdhyavo 'nnaṃ sānasi sarvaiḥ saṃbhajanīyaṃ dyumnaṃ tadīyaṃ dhanaṃ ca citraśravastamaṃ | atiśayena cāyanīyakīrtiyuktaṃ ‖ sānasi | sanoteḥ sānasiparṇasītyādināsic pratyayāṃtatvena nipātanādupadhāvṛddhiḥ | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | svamoriti svamorluk ‖*

Summary

In the Abhiplava-ṣaḍaha and in the Daśarātra, when the stomas are the seventeen-fold, the twenty-one-fold and so on, verses numbering five, seven and so on are to be inserted (āvāpa) at the place of insertion in the hotṛ-type śastras. Among them, in the Maitrāvaruṇa śastra the four verses beginning मित्रस्य चर्षन्णीधृत (*mitrasya carṣannṇīdhṛta*) are meant for insertion. This is stated in the sūtra मित्रस्य चर्षन्णीधृत इति चितस्रो मैत्र्यः (*mitrasya carṣannṇīdhṛta iti citasro maitryaḥ*) (Ā. 7-5).

Of the divine Mitra, who upholds men by giving rain, the food (avaḥ) is to be shared by all (sānasi), and his wealth (dyumna) is also most endowed with wonderful, hearable fame. On सानसि (*sānasi*) he gives a derivation: the affix is formed by the rule for words ending in -asi, and the penultimate vowel is lengthened. The word has acute accent on its final syllable because of चित्तादंतोदात्तः (*cittādaṃtodāttaḥ*); the loss of the case-ending is by the rule on sū and am.

Word-to-word meaning

- चर्षणीधृतः (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*)—who sustains all creatures by giving rain
- देवस्य (*devasya*)—who is of divine nature
- मित्रस्य (*mitrasya*)—of Mitra
- अवः (*avaḥ*)—the food
- सानसि (*sānasi*)—honoured by all

- द्युम्नं (*dyumnaṃ*)—the wealth
- चित्रश्रवस्तमं (*citraśravastamaṃ*)—is worthy of exceeding fame

Gist

The food of Mitra, who sustains all creatures by giving rain and is of divine nature, and his wealth honoured by all, are worthy of exceeding fame.

English translation

Desirable food and most renowned wealth are (the gifts) of the divine Mitra, the supporter of man

Special Topics

In the sacrifices called Abhiplava-ṣaḍaha and Daśarātra, when the seventeen-fold and twenty-one-fold stomas are recited, the priests of the hotṛ group recite verses of five, seven and similar numbers as insertion (āvapanīya) mantras among the śastra mantras they must recite. Then, when the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa recites his śastra mantra, four verses beginning मित्रस्य चर्षणीधृतः (*mitrasya carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*) (the 6th, 7th, 8th and 9th verses of this sūkta) are to be used as insertions. This is set out in the Āśvalāyana-śrautasūtra by the sūtra मित्रस्य चर्षणीधृत इति चतस्रो मैत्र्यः (*mitrasya carṣaṇīdhṛta iti catasro maitryaḥ*) (Ā. 7-5).

By the epithet चर्षणीधृतः (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*) Mitra, the support of the universe, is praised. If one examines the greatness of this epithet, the power of Mitra, that is of the Āditya in the form of Mitra, becomes clear. In this verse Sāyaṇa has said that the word चर्षणीधृतः (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*) means मनुष्याणां धारकस्य (*manuṣyāṇāṃ dhārakasya*), "the one who holds up human beings". Earlier, when explaining the sense of words such as पंचकृष्टयः (*paṃcakṛṣṭayaḥ*) and पंचजनाः (*paṃcajanāḥ*), quotations from authorities such as the Aitareya-Brāhmaṇa and the Bṛhaddevatā were cited, and it was shown that these words do not mean merely earthly human beings but include gods, humans and all. By sentences such as गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा.... (*gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā....*) (Bṛ. De. 7-68) or चक्षुःशोत्रं मनो वाक् (*cakṣuḥśotraṃ mano vāk*) (7-71), this wider sense is established

(Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, Part 12, pp. 378-381). In the Ṛk Saṃhitā too, sentences such as पंच जना मम होत्रं जुषंतां (*paṃca janā mama hotraṃ juṣaṃtāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-53-5) support the sense "gods and others". Therefore in the present verse the word चर्षणीधृतः (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*) indicates Mitra's upholding of the whole universe.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒भि यो म॑हि॒ना दिवं᳚ मि॒त्रो ब॒भूव॑ स॒प्रथा॑ः ।
अ॒भि श्रवो॑भिः पृ॒थि॒वीम् ॥ ७ ॥

> *abhi yo mahinā divaṃ mitro babhūva saprathāḥ |*
> *abhi śravobhiḥ pṛthivīm ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभि । यः । महिना । दिवं । मित्रः । बभूव । सप्रथाः ।
> अभि । श्रवःभिः । पृथिवीं ॥ ७ ॥

> *abhi | yaḥ | mahinā | divaṃ | mitraḥ | babhūva | saprathāḥ |*
> *abhi | śravaḥbhiḥ | pṛthivīṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रातर्होमस्य कालात्यये मैत्रेष्टिः । तस्यामभि यो महिनेत्यनुवाक्या ।
> सूत्रितं च । अभि यो महिना दिवं प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् । आ. ३–१२ ।
> इति ॥
> यो मित्रो महिना स्वकीयेन महिम्ना दिवमंतरिक्षमभि बभूवाभिभवति स
> मित्रः सप्रथाः प्रथः प्रसिद्धिः कीर्तिः । तत्सहितः श्रवोभिवृष्टिद्वारोत्पादितैरन्नैः
> पृथिवीमप्यभिभवति । बह्वन्नयुक्तां करोतीत्यर्थः ॥ सप्रथाः । प्रथ प्रख्याने । असुन् ।
> वोपसर्जनस्येति सहस्य सभावः ॥

> *prātarhomasya kālātyaye maitreṣṭiḥ | tasyāmabhi yo mahinetyanuvākyā |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | abhi yo mahinā divaṃ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvān |*
> *ā. 3-12 |*
> *iti ‖*

> *yo mitro mahinā svakīyena mahimnā divamaṃtarikṣamabhi*
> *babhūvābhibhavati sa*
> *mitraḥ saprathāḥ prathaḥ prasiddhiḥ kīrtiḥ | tatsahitaḥ*
> *śravobhivṛṣṭidvārotpāditairannaiḥ pṛthivīmapyabhibhavati |*
> *bahvannayuktāṃ karotītyarthaḥ ‖ saprathāḥ | pratha prakhyāne | asun*
> *|*
> *vopasarjanasyèti sahasya sabhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

When the time of the morning homa has passed, there is a Maitra offering (iṣṭi); in it the verse अभि यो महिन (*abhi yo mahina*) is the anuvākyā. It is stated in the sūtra अभि यो महिना दिवं प्र स मित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् (*abhi yo mahinā divaṃ pra sa mitra marto astu prayasvān*) (Ā. 3-12).

Mitra, who by his own greatness (mahinā) overcomes (abhi babhūva) the heaven, that is the atmosphere, that Mitra, with fame (saprathāḥ: प्रथः प्रसिद्धिः कीर्तिः (*prathaḥ prasiddhiḥ kīrtiḥ*), "praise is renown, fame"), overcomes also the earth with food produced by way of rain; that is, he makes it rich in food. On सप्रथाः (*saprathāḥ*): the root प्रथ (*pratha*) is in the sense of renown; the affix asun; sa is substituted for saha.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—which
- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—Mitra
- महिना (*mahinā*)—by his greatness
- दिवं (*divaṃ*)—the atmosphere
- अभि बभूव (*abhi babhūva*)—has overcome and pervaded (that same Mitra)
- सप्रथाः (*saprathāḥ*)—endowed with fame
- श्रवोभिः (*śravobhiḥ*)—endowed with food
- पृथिवीं (*pṛthivīṃ*)—has also pervaded the earth

Gist

Just as Mitra has overcome and pervaded the atmosphere by his greatness, so he stands pervading the earth also, joined with his fame and with food.

English translation

The renowned Mitra, who by his might presides over heaven, is he who presides over the earth by (the gift of) food.

Special Topics

In the Maitra offering, if the morning homa has passed its time, then in the homa performed as its expiation this verse अभि यो महिना (*abhi yo mahinā*) is to be used as an anuvākyā mantra. This is set out in the Āśvalāyana-śrautasūtra by the sūtra अभि ये महिना दिवं प्रसमित्र मर्तो अस्तु प्रयस्वान् (*abhi ye mahinā divaṃ prasamitra marto astu prayasvān*) (Ā. 3-12).?212

In every verse of this sūkta there is praise of the Āditya in the form of Mitra. Especially in verses 6, 7 and 8 one important, all-pervading quality of Mitra is set out. In the verse before this, the 6th, he is described as मित्रस्य चर्षणीधृतः (*mitrasya carṣaṇīdhṛtaḥ*). In the special topics on that verse it was explained that the word carṣaṇi does not mean merely human beings on earth but is a word of wide scope, indicating gods, humans and all. In the verse after this, the 8th, it is likewise described that पंच जनाः येमिरे (*paṃca janāḥ yemire*), the five peoples serve him.

अभि बभूव (*abhi babhūva*)—When the root bhū is joined with the prefix abhi it commonly means "defeat, overrun". In the present verse it means that by his lordship he has brought the whole atmosphere under his control and stands overrunning all heaven and earth. But in

अभी षू णः सखीनामविता जरित्कृणां । शतं भवास्कृतिभिः ॥ (*abhī ṣū ṇaḥ sakhīnāmavitā jaritkṛṇāṃ* | *śataṃ bhavāskṛtibhiḥ* ||) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-31-3)

the sense is, "O Indra, be (abhi bhavāsi) turned toward the singers". Elsewhere the sense is "subdue and defeat", but in this verse a coming of the nature of favour is prayed for. Even in the present verse it would not be wrong to say that Mitra stands pervading the whole atmosphere in the form of favour.

सप्रथाः (*saprathāḥ*)—प्रथः प्रसिद्धिः कीर्तिः । तत्सहितः (*prathaḥ prasiddhiḥ kīrtiḥ | tatsahitaḥ*). Pratha means fame; sapratha means one endowed with fame. The original sense of the word pratha is "to spread widely". Because a person's quality spreads widely everywhere, he becomes renowned everywhere; the sense is fame. The Nirukta-author also explains it so: after showing that सप्रथाः सर्वतः पृथुः (*saprathāḥ sarvataḥ pṛthuḥ*) means "spread out widely all round", he cites the verse त्वमग्ने सप्रथा असि .... (*tvamagne saprathā asi ....*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-13-4) and thereby shows the special sense of this word (Ni. 6-8).

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मि॒त्राय॒ पञ्च॑ येमि॒रे जना॑ अ॒भिष्टि॑शवसे ।
स दे॒वान्विश्वा॑न्बिभर्ति ॥ ८ ॥

> *mitrāya pañca yemire janā abhiṣṭiśavase |*
> *sa devānviśvānbibharti ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मित्राय । पंच । येमिरे । जनाः । अभिष्टिशवसे ।
> सः । देवान् । विश्वान् । बि भ र्ति ॥ ८ ॥

> *mitrāya | paṃca | yemire | janāḥ | abhiṣṭiśavase |*
> *saḥ | devān | viśvān | bi bha rti ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पंच जना निषादपंचमाश्चत्वारो वर्णा अभिष्टिशवसे शत्रूणामभिगंतृबलयुक्ताय मित्राय येमिरे ।
> हवींष्युद्यच्छंति । स तादृशो मित्रो विश्वान्

> *paṃca janā niṣādapaṃcamāścatvāro varṇā abhiṣṭiśavase śatrūṇāmabhigaṃtṛbalayuktāya mitrāya yemire | havīṃṣyudyacchaṃti | sa tādṛśo mitro viśvān*

> सर्वान्देवान्बिभर्ति । स्वस्वरूपतया धारयति ॥ अभिष्टिशवसे । इषेर्मंत्रे वृषेत्यादिना क्तिन् । तादौ च नितीत्यभेरंतोदात्तत्वं । शकंध्वादित्वात्पररूपत्वं । बहुव्रीह पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *sarvāndevānbibharti | svasvarūpatayā dhārayati ‖ abhiṣṭiśavase | iṣermaṃtre vṛṣetyādinā ktin | tādau ca nitītyabheraṃtodāttatvaṃ | śakaṃdhvāditvātpararūpatvaṃ | bahuvrīha pūrvapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

The five peoples (pañca janāḥ), that is the four varṇas with the Niṣāda as the fifth, offer (yemire) their oblations to Mitra, who has the strength that goes against enemies (abhiṣṭiśavase). The Gist continues in the next block.

Such a Mitra bears all the gods, holding them in his own form. On अभिष्टिशवसे (*abhiṣṭiśavase*) the remainder of the block gives derivation and accent only (the affix ktin, the accent on the final of abhi, the pararūpa and the accent of the bahuvrīhi compound).

Word-to-word meaning

- पंचजनाः (*paṃcajanāḥ*)—the people, consisting of the five classes beginning with the Niṣādas, also
- अभिष्टिशवसे (*abhiṣṭiśavase*)—who has the power to destroy enemies
- मित्राय (*mitrāya*)—to Mitra
- येमिरे (*yemire*)—offer the oblation
- सः (*saḥ*)—such a Mitra
- विश्वान् (*viśvān*)—all
- देवान् (*devān*)—the gods
- बिभर्ति (*bibharti*)—bears in his own form

Gist

The people, consisting of the five classes beginning with the Niṣādas, also offer oblation to Mitra, who has the power to destroy enemies. Such a Mitra bears all the gods in his own form.

English translation

The five classes of men have repaired to the victorious Mitra, for he supports all the gods.

Special Topics

अभिष्टिशवसे (*abhiṣṭiśavase*)—The word abhiṣṭi is commonly used in the sense of help in the form of protection. The word śavaḥ means strength. Here the sense is the power that can destroy enemies and protect the singer. The special senses of this word are explained in passages such as अभिष्टिमन्नासत्या वरूथं (*abhiṣṭimannāsatyā varūthaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-116-11).

पंच जनाः (*paṃca janāḥ*)—गंधर्वा अप्सरसो देवा असुरा रक्षांसि पंचजनाः । निषादपंचमाश्चात्वारो वर्णा वा । (*gaṃdharvā apsaraso devā asurā rakṣāṃsi paṃcajanāḥ | niṣādapaṃcamāścātvāro varṇā vā |*). Sāyaṇa's explanation is: five groups, namely Gandharvas, Apsarases, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas; or the people of the four varṇas together with the fifth group of Niṣādas, that is hunters. There are differences of opinion in this classification. The Nirukta-author, without saying what his own view is, only cites the opinions of others:

गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा असुरा रक्षांसीत्येके (*gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā asurā rakṣāṃsītyeke*) । चत्वारो वर्णा निषादः पंचम इत्यौपमन्यवः (*catvāro varṇā niṣādaḥ paṃcama ityaupamanyavaḥ*) (Ni. 3-8).

He states only the opinions of others: some hold that the five kinds of people are Gandharvas, Pitṛs, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas; Aupamanyu and others hold that the five peoples are the four varṇas beginning with Brāhmaṇas together with a fifth group, the Niṣādas.

Once, when all the gods prayed to Agni to accept the oblation offered for them in the sacrifice and to distribute it to all, Agni agreed and said:

तदद्य वाचः प्रथमं मसीय येनासुरा अभि देवा असाम । ऊर्जाद उत यज्ञियासः पंच जना मम होत्रं जुषध्वं । (*tadadya vācaḥ prathamaṃ masīya yenāsurā abhi devā asāma | ūrjāda uta yajjiyāsaḥ paṃca janā mama hotraṃ juṣadhvaṃ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-53-4)

"May the five peoples enjoy this oblation": the authors of the Bṛhaddevatā cite this sentence, which gives the answer, show the differences of opinion on who the five peoples are, and discuss them.

प्रत्युवाचाथ तानग्निर्विश्वेदेवा यदूच मां । तत्करिष्ये जुषंतां तु होत्रं पंचजना मम ॥ (*pratyuvācātha tānagnirviśvedevā yadūca māṃ | tatkariṣye juṣaṃtāṃ tu hotraṃ paṃcajanā mama ||*) (Bṛ. De. 7-66)

In this verse the answer Agni gave to the gods is stated, and afterwards the word pañcajana is explained.

शालामुख्यः प्रणीतश्च पुत्रो गृहपतेश्च यः । उत्तरो दक्षिणश्चाग्निरेते पंचजनाः स्मृताः ॥ (*śālāmukhyaḥ praṇītaśca putro gṛhapateśca yaḥ | uttaro dakṣiṇaścāgnirete paṃcajanāḥ smṛtāḥ ||*) (Bṛ. De. 7-67)

That is, the fire at the entrance of the hall, the consecrated Āhavanīya fire, the Gārhapatya fire which is as the son of the sacrificer, and the southern and northern fires, these five kinds of fires are traditionally called five classes. This is one view. Moreover:

मनुष्याः पितरो देवा गंधर्वोरगराक्षसाः । गंधर्वाः पितरो देवा असुरा यक्षराक्षसाः ॥ (*manuṣyāḥ pitaro devā gaṃdharvoragarākṣasāḥ | gaṃdharvāḥ pitaro devā asurā yakṣarākṣasāḥ ||*) (Bṛ. De. 7-68)

By the first view, one group is made of human beings and others together with serpents and Rākṣasas; in the second, Yakṣas and Rākṣasas form one group.

यास्कौपमन्यवावेतानाहतुः पंच वै जनान् । निषादपंचमान्वर्णा मन्यते शाकटायनः ॥ (*yāskaupamanyavāvetānāhatuḥ paṃca vai janān | niṣādapaṃcamānvarṇā manyate śākaṭāyanaḥ ||*) (Bṛ. De. 7-69)

In this sentence the authors of the Bṛhaddevatā say that Yāska's view is the first. But in the Nirukta the views of others are stated and Yāska's own view is not stated definitively. Perhaps he too accepted that one.

The Brihaddevatā says: "Śākapūṇi, however, holds that the *pañca janāḥ* are the priests and the sacrificer." (Bṛ. De. 7-20)

The opinion of Śākapūṇi is that the four priests beginning with the Hotṛ, together with the sacrificer, make up a group of five persons.

The Brihaddevatā continues: "Eye, ear, mind, speech and breath are the five persons, according to the teachers of the self (ātmavādins). Gandharvas and Apsarases, gods, men and fathers, and also serpents, are heard of in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa."

The eye, ear, mind, speech and breath: these five are the five persons according to the teachers of the self. The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa explains them as the Gandharvas and the rest. (Ai. Brā. 3-31-5) The explanation of the Brihaddevatā also cites these differences of opinion: that such five kinds of beings, too, may enjoy the oblation was Agni's answer to the gods. In some places the word *kṣitayaḥ* is used in place of *janāḥ*.

The word *kṣitayaḥ* is read among the twenty-five names for man, *manuṣyāḥ*, *narāḥ* and the rest. (Ni. 3-7) *Pañca kṣitīnām* means *pañca janānām*. The commentator (Yāska's) explains it as *niṣādapañcamānām*; Skandasvāmin as "of the human classes, of these: Gandharvas, fathers, gods"; and Veṅkaṭamādhava explains it as "the fivefold character of the five dwelling human races: Gandharvas, fathers, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas." According to Sāyaṇa, *kṣitīnām* means the people of five classes fit to dwell on earth: Brāhmaṇa, Kṣatriya, Vaiśya, Śūdra and Niṣāda. Niṣādas are people who do not belong to the four varṇas beginning with the Brāhmaṇa, and who live by hunting animals. The Gonds, Kolas, Bhillas and others, former inhabitants of this country, belong to this class. They still live, in very small numbers, only in a few places such as the Central Provinces. The words *pañca janāḥ* and *pañca kṛṣṭīḥ* occur in many places in the Ṛgveda.

In sum, some say the five kinds of people are Gandharvas, fathers, gods, Asuras and Rākṣasas. The view of Upamanyu and others is that the five kinds are the people of the four varṇas beginning with the Brāhmaṇa, together with the hunter class called Niṣāda (Sāyaṇa has endorsed this). The Nairuktas say that Niṣādas are those who kill animals, or that they are so called because sin is full in them. It may also be that there were five main tribes at that time, and the poet may have said *pañca janāḥ* with this in mind. At all events it is clear that there was a difference of opinion on this matter even in the time of Yāska, the author of the Nirukta.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मि॒त्रो दे॒वेष्वा॒युषु॒ जना॑य वृ॒क्तब॑र्हिषे ।
इष॑ इ॒ष्टव्र॑ता अकः ॥ ९ ॥

> *mitro deveṣvāyuṣu janāya vṛktabarhiṣe |*
> *iṣa iṣṭavratā akaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मित्रः । देवेषु । आयुषु । जनाय । वृक्तबर्हिषे ।
> इषः । इष्टव्रताः । अकरित्यकः ॥ ९ ॥

> *mitraḥ | deveṣu | āyuṣu | janāya | vṛktabarhiṣe |*
> *iṣaḥ | iṣṭavratāḥ | akarityakaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मित्रो भगवानादित्यो देवेषु द्योतमानादिगुणयुक्तेष्टायुषु मनुष्येषु मध्यॆ यो जनो व्यक्तबर्हिः । व्यक्तं लूनं बर्हिर्येन सः । बर्हिर्लवनासादनपूर्वं हविषो दाता ऋत्विगित्यर्थः । तस्मै व्यक्तबर्हिषे जनायेष्टव्रताः ।
> इष्टानि कल्याणानि व्रतानि कर्माणि याभिः सिध्यंति ता इषस्तादृशान्यन्नान्यकः । करोति । तस्मै ददातीत्यर्थः ॥ व्यक्तबर्हिषे । ओव्रश्च छेदने । कर्मणि निष्ठायां यस्य विभाषेतीतप्रतिषेधः । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । अकः । करोतेर्लुजः चेर्मंत्रे घसेत्यादिना लुक् । सिपो हल्बादिलोपः । निघातः ॥

> *mitro bhagavānādityo deveṣu dyotamānādiguṇayukteṣṭāyuṣu manuṣyeṣu madhyè yo jano vyaktabarhiḥ | vyaktaṃ lūnaṃ barhiryena saḥ | barhirlavanāsādanapūrvaṃ haviṣo dātā ṛtvigityarthaḥ | tasmai vyaktabarhiṣe janāyeṣṭavratāḥ |*

> *iṣṭāni kalyāṇāni vratāni karmāṇi yābhiḥ sidhyaṃti tā*
> *iṣastādṛśānyannānyakaḥ | karoti |*
> *tasmai dadātītyarthaḥ ‖ vyaktabarhiṣe | ovraśca chedane | karmaṇi*
> *niṣṭhāyāṃ yasya*
> *vibhāṣetītapratiṣedhaḥ | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ | akaḥ |*
> *karoterlujaḥ cermaṃtre*
> *ghasetyādinā luk | sipo halbādilopaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Mitra, the divine Āditya, among the gods and among men, that is, those endowed with brilliance and similar qualities, does this for the person who is *vyaktabarhis*: one by whom the sacred grass has been cut (*vyaktam* = *lūnam*). The meaning is the priest who gives the oblation after cutting and spreading the grass. For that person Mitra produces *iṣṭavratāḥ* foods (*iṣaḥ*): foods by which the auspicious (*iṣṭāni*, *kalyāṇāni*) rites (*vratāni*) are accomplished. That is, Mitra gives him such foods.

Word-to-word meaning

- मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)—Āditya in the form of Mitra
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—possessing shining qualities
- आयुषु (*āyuṣu*)—among men
- व्यक्तबर्हिषे (*vyaktabarhiṣe*)—who stands ready, having spread the darbha grass for the performance of the rite
- जनाय (*janāya*)—to the sacrificer
- इष्टव्रताः (*iṣṭavratāḥ*)—fit for the performance of auspicious observances
- इषः (*iṣaḥ*)—foods
- अकः (*akaḥ*)—produces

Gist

Mitra, in the form of Āditya, produces foods fit for the performance of auspicious observances for the sacrificer, who among men of shining qualities has spread the darbha grass and stands ready for the rite.

English translation

Mitra is he who amongst gods and men bestows food as the reward of pious acts upon the man who has prepared (for him) the lopped sacred grass.

Special Topics

देवेषु आयुषु (*deveṣu āyuṣu*): the commentator explains this as "among men endowed with shining and similar qualities". Since the word *āyavaḥ* is read among the names for men (Ni. 3-7), *āyuṣu* means "among men". But the commentator's explanation, which makes *deveṣu* an adjective of the word *āyuṣu*, does not fit well. If the natural sense of this word, "among the gods", is given, the sense fits properly. Therefore it is appropriate not to take *deveṣu* and *āyuṣu* as qualifier and qualified, but to regard both as independent words and explain "among the gods and among men". The sense then fits well.

वृक्तबर्हिषे (*vṛktabarhiṣe*): the meaning of the word *barhis* has been explained before. *Barhis* is a kind of grass called darbha, long in form. The priests bring it, cut off its pointed tips, cut it to one equal length, and spread it in a fixed place in the sacrificial ground as a seat, so that the gods may come and sit. In spreading it, so that it may be soft for those who sit, they first lay some of the darbhas as a layer lengthwise, over that another layer crosswise, and over that another lengthwise as at first. It is the custom to spread the darbhas in three layers in this way. There is also a Śruti sentence on this: त्रिवृद्बर्हिर्भवति । माता पिता पुत्रः । (*trivṛdbarhirbhavati | mātā pitā putraḥ |*) Because the tips of the darbhas are very sharp, they cut off the tips so that they will not prick. In many Ṛks the invited gods are begged to come and sit on the seat prepared in this way, with the equal-length darbhas spread in three layers one upon another. In the present Ṛk, the word व्यक्तबर्हिषे (*vyaktabarhiṣe*) indicates that the sacrificer performing the sacrifice has prepared such a darbha seat.

इष्टव्रताः (*iṣṭavratāḥ*): इष्टानि कल्याणानि व्रतानि कर्माणि याभिः सिध्यंति ताः इषः । (*iṣṭāni kalyāṇāni vratāni karmāṇi yābhiḥ sidhyaṃti tāḥ iṣaḥ |*) This word is an adjective of the word *iṣaḥ*. So the commentator's explanation is: such foods (in the form of oblations) by which auspicious rites are accomplished. That is, rites performed with reference to the foods in the form of oblations offered to satisfy the gods in sacrifices and the like are accomplished by offering such foods in the form of oblations. These foods are therefore the means of the accomplishment of rites. What is said here is the prayer to Mitra to give us such foods.

Sūkta 60

The deities of this sūkta are the Ṛbhus. It is necessary to know their earlier history, the deeds of daring they performed, and the skill of mind they showed in their works.

It is said in many places in the Ṛgveda that the Ṛbhus were formerly men and attained divinity by their excellent conduct and the performance of good rites. In the past the sage Aṅgiras had a son named Nītimañjari. In his line the sage Sudhanvan had three sons, Ṛbhu, Vibhu and Vāja. It is traditionally said that through good works, such as performing good rites and helping the gods, they attained birth as gods or became gods. These three sons of Sudhanvan, beginning with Ṛbhu, are customarily all called Ṛbhus. All three sons are called by the name of the eldest. Because they were pupils of Tvaṣṭṛ, they are also called the craftsmen of the gods. It is said in various places that they made the necessary implements for the gods beginning with Indra, namely Indra's chariot and Agni's *camasa* vessel. This sūkta describes some works they did. Descriptions elsewhere say that they have wondrous power and are able to do any kind of work. Since they have the same power and capacity as the gods, the sages regarded them as belonging to the company of the gods and described them and their deeds in many ways. It is traditionally said that they dwell in the orb of the sun and do their works through the sun's rays.

Yāska has given three etymologies of the word Ṛbhu:

1. ऋभव उरु भांतीति वा । (*ṛbhava uru bhāṃtīti vā* |) *Uru*, greatly; *bhānti*, they shine; therefore they are called Ṛbhus. Here, according to some, the word arises by joining the final letter *ru* of *uru* and the first letter of *bhānti*, making *rubhu* or *ṛbhu*, as in *ahaḥ* + *rātri* = *horā*.
2. ऋतेन भांतीति इति वा । (*ṛtena bhāṃtīti iti vā* |) *Ṛtena* means "by truth or by sacrifice"; because they shine by it, they are called Ṛbhus.
3. ऋतेन भवंतीति वा ॥ (*ṛtena bhavaṃtīti vā* ‖) *Ṛtena* means "by strength (capacity)"; because they exist by strength, that is, are possessed of capacity, they are called Ṛbhus. Of the word *ṛtena*

the first letter *ṛ* and the first letter *bha* of the word *bhavanti* combine to give *ṛbhu*, some say.

This Ṛk makes clear that these Ṛbhus were formerly men and afterwards attained divinity:

विष्ट्वी शमी तरणित्वेन वाघतो मर्तासः संतो अमृतत्वमानशुः । सौधन्वना ऋभवः सूरचक्षसः संवत्सरे समपृच्यंत धीतिभिः ॥ (*viṣṭvī śamī taraṇitvena vāghato martāsaḥ saṃto amṛtatvamānaśuḥ* | *saudhanvanā ṛbhavaḥ sūracakṣasaḥ saṃvatsare samapṛcyaṃta dhītibhiḥ* ‖) (Saṃ. Saṃ. 1,110-4)?213

Yāska's Nirukta on it: कृत्वा कर्माणि क्षिप्रत्वेन वोढारो मेधाविनो वा मर्तासः संतो अमृततत्वमानशिरे ऋभवः सूरख्याना ना सूरप्रज्ञा वा, संवत्सरे समपृच्यंत धीतिभिः कर्मभिः ॥ (*kṛtvā karmāṇi kṣipratvena voḍhāro medhāvino vā martāsaḥ saṃto amṛtatatvamānaśire ṛbhavaḥ sūrakhyānā nā sūraprajñā vā, saṃvatsare samapṛcyaṃta dhītibhiḥ karmabhiḥ* ‖)

The chief sense is this: these Ṛbhus, sons of Sudhanvan, were formerly men. By their insight or intellectual power, equal to the sun, they quickly, that is, within a single year, performed all the sacrifices and attained *amṛtatva*, that is, divinity (freedom from death).

Yāska has also given another meaning of the word Ṛbhu: आदित्यरश्मयोऽस्यभव उच्यंते (*ādityaraśmayo 'syabhava ucyaṃte*), that is, the rays of the sun are also called *ṛbhavaḥ*. For example:

उद्वत्समा अकृणोतना तृणं निवत्स्वपः स्वपस्यया नरः । अगो ह्यस्य यदसस्तना गृहे तदद्येदमृभवो नानु गच्छथ ॥ (*udvatsamā akṛṇotanā tṛṇaṃ nivatsvapaḥ svapasyayā naraḥ | ago hyasya yadasastanā gṛhe tadadyedamṛbhavo nānu gacchatha* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-61-11)[?214]

On this Ṛk Yāska gave the Nirukta: अगोह्य आदित्योऽगूहनीयस्तस्य यदस्वपथ गृहे यावत्तत्र भवथ न तावदिह भवथेति । (*agohya ādityo 'gūhanīyastasya yadasvapatha gṛhe yāvattatra bhavatha na tāvadiha bhavatheti* |) The commentator too, explaining this Ṛk, interprets the word *ṛbhavaḥ* thus: ऋभवः उरु प्रभूतं भासमानाः ऋतेनादित्येन भासमाना ना ऋतेनोडकेनोदकार्थमुत्पन्ना वा (*ṛbhavaḥ uru prabhūtaṃ bhāsamānāḥ ṛtenādityena bhāsamānā nā ṛtenoḍakenodakārthamutpannā vā*).

In Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-2 the background of the earlier history indicates that the Ṛbhus went to the house of Savitṛ, who had offered an oblation in the sacrifice or given hospitality. Skandasvāmin has explained this history in one way, Sāyaṇa in another. In this connection:

अत्रेतिहासमचक्षते । ऋभवो यज्ञियत्वं प्रार्थयमानाः प्रजापतेः सकाशमगमन् । अथ प्रजापतिः सवितारमाहूयावोचत् । एतेऽपि यज्ञि- (*atretihāsamacakṣate | ṛbhavo yajñiyatvaṃ prārthayamānāḥ prajāpateḥ sakāśamagaman | atha prajāpatiḥ savitāramāhūyāvocat | ete 'pi yajji-*)

या भवंत्विति । तथेति सविता प्रतिपद्य तान् स्वगृहं नीत्वा द्वादश दिनान्या तिथ्यमेषामकार्षिदिति । तदेतद्वामदेवो वक्ष्यति । (*yā bhavaṃtviti | tatheti savitā pratipadya tān svagṛhaṃ nītvā dvādaśa dinānyā tithyameṣāmakārṣiditi | tadetadvāmadevo vakṣyati* |)

The Ṛbhus, wishing to obtain the right to take part in the sacrifice and receive the oblation, went to Prajāpati. Prajāpati then called Savitṛ and said, "Let these too become fit for sacrifice (help them in this)." Savitṛ agreed, saying "So be it", took them to his house and performed hospitality for them for twelve days. Skandasvāmin tells the story briefly thus, and cites the Ṛk that indicates this setting:

द्वादश द्यून्यदगोह्यस्यातिथ्ये रणन्नृभवः ससंतः । सुक्षेत्राकृण्वन्ननयंत सिंधून्धन्वातिष्ठन्नोषधीर्निम्नमापः ॥ (*dvādaśa dyūnyadagohyasyātithye raṇannṛbhavaḥ sasaṃtaḥ | sukṣetrākṛṇvannanayaṃta siṃdhūndhanvātiṣṭhannoṣadhīrnimnamāpaḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4.33-7)

In the same connection Sāyaṇa indicates the cause that brought the Ṛbhus to Savitṛ's house:

दाशुषः प्रातःसवनादिष्टग्न्यादिभिरपसारितेभ्य ऋभुभ्यः सोमपानं दत्तवतः सवितुः गृहं निवासस्थानं तृतीयसवनाख्यमगच्छत प्राप्ताः ॥ (*dāśuṣaḥ prātaḥsavanādiṣṭagnyādibhirapasāritebhya ṛbhubhyaḥ somapānaṃ dattavataḥ savituḥ gṛhaṃ nivāsasthānaṃ tṛtīyasavanākhyamagacchata prāptāḥ ‖*)

"Enter the sacrificial house, of the form of the third pressing, of Savitṛ who gave the Soma-drink to you Ṛbhus, who had been rejected and sent out by Agni and the other gods at the morning pressing and the rest." In this way he also states the rejection by Agni and the others. This matter is told fully in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa:

यभवो वै देवेषु तपसा सोमपीथमभ्यजयंस्तेभ्यः प्रातःसवने वाचि कल्पयिषंस्तानग्निर्वसुभिः प्रातःसवनादनुदत तेभ्यो माध्यंदिने सवने वाचि कल्पयिषंस्तानिंद्रो रुद्रैर्माध्यंदिनात्सवनादनुदत तेभ्यस्तृतीयसवने वाचि कल्पयिषंस्तान्विश्वे देवा अनोनुद्यंत नेह पास्यंति नेहेति स प्रजापतिरब्रवीत्सवितारं तव वा इमेंतेवासास्त्रमेवैभिः संपिबस्वेति स तथेत्यब्रवीत्सविता तान्वै त्वमुभयतः परिपिबेति तान्प्रजापतिरुभयतः पर्यपिबत् । (*yabhavo vai deveṣu tapasā somapīthamabhyajayaṃstebhyaḥ prātaḥsavane vāci kalpayiṣaṃstānagnirvasubhiḥ prātaḥsavanādanudata tebhyo mādhyaṃdine savane vāci kalpayiṣaṃstāniṃdro rudrairmādhyaṃdinātsavanādanudata tebhyastṛtīyasavane vāci kalpayiṣaṃstānviśve devā anonudyaṃta neha pāsyaṃti neheti sa prajāpatirabravītsavitāraṃ tava vā imeṃtevāsāstramevaibhiḥ saṃpibasveti sa tathetyabravītsavitā tānvai tvamubhayataḥ paripibeti tānprajāpatirubhayataḥ paryapibat* |) (Ai. Brā. 13-30)[?215]

The Ṛbhus, by their austerity and intense desire, gained a share of Soma-drinking among the gods. When they first wished to have it at the morning pressing, Agni joined with the Vasus, rejected them and drove them away. Then, when they wished to obtain it at the midday pressing, Indra joined with the Rudras and drove them away. Again, at the third pressing they wished to obtain it

When they desired to obtain it at the third savana, the Viśvedevas rejected them there too with harsh words: "You are certainly not entitled to drink Soma here; you must not do it." Then Prajāpati said to Savitṛ: "These Ṛbhus are your pupils. Drink Soma together with them." Savitṛ then agreed. Prajāpati too drank the Soma-juice at their side. Sāyaṇa has stated briefly the circumstances that the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa relates at length.

A few examples can be given of the Ṛbhus' skill in craft. Their skill is praised in that the single chamasa vessel, when it had been made by Tvaṣṭṛ, was made by them into four vessels. This is as said in the Ṛc

उत त्यं चमसं नवं त्वष्टुर्देवस्य निष्कृतं । अकर्त चतुरः पुनः । (*uta tyaṃ camasaṃ navaṃ tvaṣṭurdevasya niṣkṛtaṃ | akarta caturaḥ punaḥ |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-20-6)

and as the same account is given further on in Ṛcs such as

ज्येष्ठ आह चमसा द्वा करेति कनीयान्त्रिन्कृणवामेत्याह । कनिष्ठ आह चतुरस्करेति त्वष्ट यभवस्तत्पनयद्वचो वः ॥ (*jyeṣṭha āha camasā dvā kareti kanīyāntrinkṛṇavāmetyāha | kaniṣṭha āha caturaskareti tvaṣṭa yabhavastatpanayadvaco vaḥ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-33-5)

It is well known that they made one vessel into four by their skill. In this work too, it is stated in the Bṛhaddevatā that this power came to them through Tvaṣṭṛ's instruction and that they were Tvaṣṭṛ's pupils:

सुधन्वन आंगिरसस्यासन्नुत्रास्तयः पुरा । ऋभुर्विभ्वा च वाजश्च शिष्यास्त्वष्टुश्च तेभवन् ॥ (*sudhanvana āṃgirasasyāsannutrāstayaḥ purā | ṛbhurvibhvā ca vājaśca śiṣyāstvaṣṭuśca tebhavan ‖*)

शिक्षयामास तांस्वष्टा त्वाष्ट्रं यत्कर्म किंचन । परिनिष्ठितकर्माणो विश्वेदेवा उपाह्वयन् ॥ (*śikṣayāmāsa tāṃsvaṣṭā tvāṣṭraṃ yatkarma kiṃcana | pariniṣṭhitakarmāṇo viśvedevā upāhvayan ‖*)

विश्वेषां ते ततश्चक्रु र्वाहनान्यायुधानि तु । धेनुं सबर्दुघां चक्रुरमृतं सबरुच्यते ॥ (*viśveṣāṃ te tataścakru rvāhanānyāyudhāni tu | dhenuṃ sabardughāṃ cakruramṛtaṃ sabarucyate ‖*)

बृहस्पतेरथाश्विभ्यां रथं दिव्यं त्रिवंधुरं । इंद्राय च हरी देवप्रहीतेनाग्नि नापि यत् ॥ (*bṛhaspaterathāśvibhyāṃ rathaṃ divyaṃ trivaṃdhuraṃ | iṃdrāya ca harī devaprahītenāgni nāpi yat ‖*)

एकं चमसमित्युक्तेज्येष्ठ आहेत्यथो दिवि । उक्त्वा ततक्षुश्चमसन् यथोक्तं तेन हर्षिताः ॥ (*ekaṃ camasamityukte jyeṣṭha āhetyatho divi | uktvā tatakṣuścamasan yathoktaṃ tena harṣitāḥ ‖*)

त्वष्टा च सविता चैव देवदेवः प्रजापतिः । सर्वान्देवान् समामंत्र अमृतत्वं वदुश्च ते ॥ (*tvaṣṭā ca savitā caiva devadevaḥ prajāpatiḥ | sarvāndevān samāmaṃtra amṛtatvaṃ vaduśca te ‖*)

तेषामाद्यांत्ययोर्नाम्ना दृश्यते बहुवत् स्तवः । तृतीयसवने तेषां तैस्तु भागः प्रकल्पितः ॥ अपिबत्सोममिंद्रश्च तैस्तत्र सवने सह ॥ (*teṣāmādyāṃtyayornāmnā dṛśyate bahuvat stavaḥ | tṛtīyasavane teṣāṃ taistu bhāgaḥ prakalpitaḥ ‖ apibatsomamiṃdraśca taistatra savane saha ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 3-83 to 89)

In former times the three sons of Sudhanvan, Ṛbhu, Vibhvan and Vāja, became pupils of Tvaṣṭṛ. Tvaṣṭṛ, skilled in all the arts, taught them too all the arts. Then the Viśvedevas, expert in the arts, confronted them with hostility. Then they made weapons and vehicles for all the gods. After that they created a cow that gives immortality. For Bṛhaspati and the Aśvins they made chariots with three seats, for Indra horses, and for Agni, who had been sent by the gods as messenger, what was said, that is,

किमु श्रेष्ठः किं यविष्टो न आजगन्कमीयते दूत्यं १ कद्यदूचिम । न निंदिम चमसं यो महाकुलोऽग्ने भ्रातर्दुण इद्भूतिमूदिम ॥ (*kimu śreṣṭhaḥ kiṃ yaviṣṭo na ājagankamīyate dūtyaṃ 1 kadyadūcima | na niṃdima camasaṃ yo mahākulo 'gne bhrātarduṇa idbhūtimūdima ‖*)

एकं चमसं चतुरः कृणोतन तद्वो देवा अब्रुवन्तद्व आगमं । सौधन्वना यद्येवा करिष्यथ साकं देवैर्यज्ञियासो भविष्यथ ॥ (*ekaṃ camasaṃ caturaḥ kṛṇotana tadvo devā abruvantadva āgamaṃ | saudhanvanā yadyevā kariṣyatha sākaṃ devairyajñiyāso bhaviṣyatha ‖*)

अग्निं दूतं प्रति यदब्रनीतनाश्वः कर्त्वा रथ उतेह कर्त्त्वः । धेनुः कर्त्वा युवशा कर्त्वा द्वा तानि भ्रातरनु वः कृत्वेमसि ॥ (*agniṃ dūtaṃ prati yadabranītanāśvaḥ kartvā ratha uteha karttvaḥ | dhenuḥ kartvā yuvaśā kartvā dvā tāni bhrātaranu vaḥ kṛtvemasi ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-161-1 to 3)

As described in these Ṛcs, Agni went as the gods' messenger to the sons of Sudhanvan and told them that if they made the single chamasa vessel into four and helped the gods, they would then gain the right to drink Soma-juice along with them. They replied that this was not their only work: whether the making of a horse, the making of a chariot, the making of a cow, or the making of their aged parents young again, all this was possible for them, and in the same way now too they would do for the gods everything desired. This is what is indicated here, and they did it. Thus by such skilful work they helped Agni. Then Tvaṣṭṛ, Savitṛ and Prajāpati, the god of gods, called all the gods and granted that immortality should be won by the Ṛbhus. Then Indra too (who had first rejected them) drank Soma-juice together with them. This story is told in the Bṛhaddevatā.

The story told in Sāyaṇa's bhāṣya is as follows:

पुरा कस्यचिदृषेर्धेनुर्मृता । स ऋषिस्तस्या धेनोर्वत्सं दृष्ट्वा ऋभुं तुष्टाव । ऋभवस्तत्सदृशीमन्यां धेनुं (*purā kasyacidṛṣerdhenurmṛtā | sa ṛṣistasyā dhenorvatsaṃ dṛṣṭvā ṛbhuṃ tuṣṭāva | ṛbhavastatsadṛśīmanyāṃ dhenuṃ*)

कृत्वा तदीयेन चर्मणा संवीय तेन वत्सेन समयोजयन्निति । (*kṛtvā tadīyena carmaṇā saṃvīya tena vatsena samayojayanniti |*)

That is: formerly the cow of a certain ṛṣi died. Out of pity for its small calf, he prayed to the Ṛbhus to help it. Then the Ṛbhus created another cow, covered it with the skin of the dead cow, and united it with that calf. This is their greatness. According to Skandasvāmin's explanation:

अत्रेतिहासमाचक्षते । ऋषेकस्यचिदग्निहोत्रधेनुस्तरुणवत्सा ममार । तस्यां विकर्तितायां आरुदता वत्सेन उद्वेजितः ऋभून् स्वपितरौ वृद्धौ पुनर्यु वानौ कुर्वतो ददर्श । तानुवाच । ममाप्यग्निहोत्रधेनुं मृतां. पुनर्जीवयतेति । तस्य स्वमाहात्म्येन तस्माच्चर्मणः तामेव गां अशेषा वयवोपेतां चक्रुः इति । तदेतदिहोच्यते निश्चर्मण इति । (*atretihāsamācakṣate | ṛṣekasyacidagnihotradhenustaruṇavatsā mamāra | tasyāṃ vikartitāyāṃ ārudatā vatsena udvejitaḥ ṛbhūn svapitarau vṛddhau punaryu vānau kurvato dadarśa | tānuvāca | mamāpyagnihotradhenuṃ mṛtāṃ. punarjīvayateti | tasya svamāhātmyena tasmāccarmaṇaḥ tāmeva gāṃ aśeṣā vayavopetāṃ cakruḥ iti | tadetadihocyate niścarmaṇa iti |*)

The agnihotra cow of a certain ṛṣi died, leaving her young calf. While she was being cut up, the ṛṣi, hearing the piteous cry of the young calf, was moved with pity and remembered the Ṛbhus. They were then making their aged parents young again. Seeing that power of theirs, he asked that his dead agnihotra cow too be brought to life. They made that dead cow, by means of the same cut-off skin as covering, complete in all her limbs, and brought her to life. So it is said. The main difference between what Sāyaṇa says and this is that he says अन्यां धेनुं कृत्वा (*anyāṃ dhenuṃ kṛtvā*), while Skandasvāmin says तामेव गां अशेषावयवोपेतां चक्रुः (*tāmeva gāṃ aśeṣāvayavopetāṃ cakruḥ*).

The word ṛbhu is probably derived from the root रभ् (*rabh*) ("to grasp"); compare 2-3-8. Hence the word means "serving in time of need" or "dexterous". The word ṛbhu is used many times in this same sense as an epithet of Indra, Agni and the Ādityas. The word vāja means "capable", and vibhvan "renowned". Therefore the words Ṛbhu and the rest are names that fit their meaning and also indicate their skill.

It is clear that they were not gods at first. But what their nature was before becoming gods is not clear. Even when they are called Saudhanvas it is not known who they are. The word sudhanvan is used in the Ṛgveda only twice, applied to Rudra and the Maruts. As is said in many places, Heaven and Earth may be their parents. Because they dwelt in the house of Savitṛ, which cannot be hidden, it may be said that they have the power to make the earth fertile. Many scholars

hold that these three are presiding spirits of three seasons; that their sleeping twelve days refers to the seasons' not moving for twelve days at the time of the Makara Saṅkrānti; that the bowl is the moon, and its becoming four is the four forms of the moon. On the whole it may be said that they are supernatural beings of the earth or the atmosphere, and that their skill caused many tales of bold deeds to arise about them. But if the Ṛgveda alone is taken as the basis, there is no room for any fixed opinion.

Sūkta 60 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इहेह व इति सप्तर्चं सप्तमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रं जागतमृभुडेवताकं ।
> अंत्यस्तृच इंद्रदेवताकश्च । तथा चानुक्रांतं । इहेह वः सप्तार्भवं जागतं
> तृचोऽंत्य ऐंद्रश्चेति ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः । आद्याश्चतस्रः पृष्टाभिप्लवषडहयोः प्रथमेऽहनि
> वैश्वदेवशस्त्र आर्भवनिविद्धानीयाः । सूत्रितं च । इहेह व इति
> चतस्रः । आ. ७–५ । इति ॥

> *iheha va iti saptarcaṃ saptamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitraṃ*
> *jāgatamṛbhuḍevatākaṃ |*
> *aṃtyastṛca iṃdradevatākaśca | tathā cānukrāṃtaṃ | iheha vaḥ*
> *saptārbhavaṃ jāgataṃ*
> *tṛco 'ṃtya aiṃdraśceti ‖ sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ | ādyāścatasraḥ*
> *pṛṣṭābhiplavaṣaḍahayoḥ prathame 'hani vaiśvadevaśastra*
> *ārbhavanividdhānīyāḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | iheha va iti*
> *catasraḥ | ā. 7-5 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning इहेह वः (*iheha vaḥ*), of seven Ṛcs, is the seventh sūkta (of the anuvāka). Its seer is of the line of Viśvāmitra; its metre is Jagatī; its deity is the Ṛbhus, and the last tṛca (three Ṛcs) has Indra as deity. Sāyaṇa cites the Anukramaṇī: इहेह वः सप्तार्भवं जागतं तृचोऽंत्य ऐंद्रश्चेति (*iheha vaḥ saptārbhavaṃ jāgataṃ tṛco 'ṃtya aiṃdraśceti*). The use of the sūkta is Laiṅgika (by the indication of its content). The first four Ṛcs are to be used in the Vaiśvadeva śastra on the first day of the Pṛṣṭhya and Abhiplava ṣaḍahas, as Ārbhava nivid-dhānīya verses. He gives the sūtra: इहेह व इति चतस्रः । आ. ७-५ । इति (*iheha va iti catasraḥ | ā. 7-5 | iti*).

Anuvāda: This sūkta beginning "ihe-ha vaḥ" is the seventh sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has seven Ṛcs. Viśvāmitra is the ṛṣi; the Ṛbhus are the deity; the last three Ṛcs have Indra as deity; the metre is Jagatī. The Anukramaṇī says: "ihe-ha vaḥ: seven, Ārbhava, Jagatī; the last tṛca is Aindra." The use of the sūkta is Laiṅgika. When the Vaiśvadeva śastra mantras are recited on the first day of the sacrifices called Pṛṣṭhya and Abhiplava ṣaḍaha, the first four Ṛcs of this sūkta are to be recited as nivid-dhānīya mantras with the Ṛbhus as deity. This is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra "ihe-ha va iti catasraḥ" (Ā. 7-5).

Sūkta 60. Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 5; Sūkta 60. Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 4; Varga 7. Number of Ṛcs in the sūkta: 7. Ṛṣi: Viśvāmitra. Deity: 1–4 the Ṛbhus; 5–7 the Ṛbhus and Indra. Metre: Jagatī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒हेह॑ वो॒ मन॑सा ब॒न्धुता॑ नर उ॒शिजो॑ जग्मुर॒भि तानि॒ वेद॑सा ।
याभि॑र्मा॒याभि॒ः प्रति॑जूतिवर्पस॒ः सौध॑न्वना य॒ज्ञियं॑ भा॒गमा॑न॒श ॥ १ ॥

> *iheha vo manasā bandhutā nara uśijo jagmurabhi tāni vedasā |*
> *yābhirmāyābhiḥ pratijūtivarpasaḥ saudhanvanā yajñiyaṃ bhāgamānaśa ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इहह । वः । मनसा । बंधुता । नरः । उशिजः । जग्मुः । अभि । तानि । वेदसा ।
> याभिः । मायाभिः । प्रतिजूतिवर्पसः । सौधन्वनाः । यज्ञियं । भागं । आनश ॥ १ ॥

> *ihaha | vaḥ | manasā | baṃdhutā | naraḥ | uśijaḥ | jagmuḥ | abhi | tāni | vedasā |*
> *yābhiḥ | māyābhiḥ | pratijūtivarpasaḥ | saudhanvanāḥ | yajñiyaṃ | bhāgaṃ | ānaśa ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋभवो वो युष्माकं बंधुता । बध्वंति फलेन संयोजयंतीति
> बंधवः कर्माणि । तेषां समूहो बंधुता । इहेह सर्वत्र मनसा सर्वैर्ज्ञायते । नरो हि मनुष्या ऋभव
> उशिजो यज्ञभागं कामयमाना भवंतो

> वेदसा यज्ञभागप्रापककर्मविषयज्ञानेन तानि तादृशानि कर्माण्यभि जग्मुः ।
> प्राप्नुवंति । कानि तानि । मायाभिः । मायंते ज्ञायंत इति मायाः कर्माणि ।
> याभिर्मायाभिर्यैः कर्मभिः प्रतिजूतिवर्पसः प्रतिपक्षाभिभवनशीलतेजोयुक्ताः
> सौधन्वनाः । सुधन्वनामांगिरसः पुत्रः कश्चि दृष्टिः । तस्य पुत्राः सौधन्वनाः । ते च त्रय
> यभुर्विभ्वा वाज इति । एतन्नामका यूयं यज्ञियं यज्ञार्हं भागं सोमपानादिलक्षणमानश । प्राप्ताः
> स्थ । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । ऋभुर्विभ्वा वाजो देवा
> अगच्छत स्वपसो यज्ञियं भागमैतन । ऋग्वे. १ १६१–६ । इति । आयमर्थो
> ब्राह्मणेऽप्यभवो वै देवेषु तपसा सोमपीथमभ्यजयन्नित्यत्रोपख्यानपूर्वकं
> स्पष्टमभिहित यद्वा । नरः कर्मणां नेतारो हे ऋभव उरिजः कामयमाना
> वेदसा हविर्लक्षणेन धनेन युक्ताः स्तोतारो वो युष्माकं तानि चमसतक्षण.
> दीनि कर्माणि बंधुता बंधुतया सख्येन मनसा जगुः । अभिगच्छंति । कानीता, श
> कायावाह । यैश्चमसतक्षणादिभिः कर्मभिर्यज्ञार्हं भागं यूयमाल्वत
> शान्यभिगच्छंति । युष्माकं बुद्धिनैपुणानि चिंतयंतीत्यर्थः । इहेह नित्यं

> *he ṛbhavo vo yuṣmākaṃ baṃdhutā | badhvaṃti phalena saṃyojayaṃtīti baṃdhavaḥ karmāṇi | teṣāṃ samūho baṃdhutā | iheha sarvatra manasā sarvairjñāyate | naro hi manuṣyā ṛbhava uśijo yajñabhāgaṃ kāmayamānā bhavaṃto*
> *vedasā yajñabhāgaprāpakakarmaviṣayajñānena tāni tādṛśāni karmāṇyabhi jagmuḥ |*
> *prāpnuvaṃti | kāni tāni | māyābhiḥ | māyaṃte jñāyaṃta iti māyāḥ karmāṇi |*
> *yābhirmāyābhiryaiḥ karmabhiḥ pratijūtivarpasaḥ pratipakṣābhibhavanaśīlatejoyuktāḥ*
> *saudhanvanāḥ | sudhanvanāmāṃgirasaḥ putraḥ kaści dṛṣṭiḥ | tasya putrāḥ saudhanvanāḥ | te ca traya*
> *yabhurvibhvā vāja iti | etannāmakā yūyaṃ yajñiyaṃ yajñārhaṃ bhāgaṃ somapānādilakṣaṇamānaśa | prāptāḥ stha | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | ṛbhurvibhvā vājo devā*
> *agacchata svapaso yajñiyaṃ bhāgamaitana | ṛgve. 1 161-6 | iti | āyamartho*
> *brāhmaṇe 'pyabhavo vai deveṣu tapasā somapīthamabhyajayannityatropakhyānapūrvakaṃ*
> *spaṣṭamabhihita yadvā | naraḥ karmaṇāṃ netāro he ṛbhava urijaḥ kāmayamānā*
> *vedasā havirlakṣaṇena dhanena yuktāḥ stotāro vo yuṣmākaṃ tāni camasatakṣaṇa.*

> *dīni karmāṇi baṃdhutā baṃdhutayā sakhyena manasā jaguḥ |*
> *abhigacchaṃti | kānītā, śa*
> *kāyāvāha | yaiścamasatakṣaṇādibhiḥ karmabhiryajñārhaṃ bhāgaṃ yūyamālvata*
> *śānyabhigacchaṃti | yuṣmākaṃ buddhinaipuṇāni ciṃtayaṃtītyarthaḥ | iheha nityaṃ*

> योरिति द्विर्वचनं । परस्याम्रेडितत्वादनुदात्तत्वे पूर्वपदस्वरः । बंधुता । बन्द
> बंधने । शून्यस्त्वस्निहीत्यादिना कर्तर्युप्रत्ययः । समूह इत्यर्थे ग्रामजनबंधुसहायेभ्यस्तल् ।
> पा. ४–२–४३ । इति तल् । लित्स्वरः ॥

> *yoriti dvirvacanaṃ | parasyāmreḍitatvādanudāttatve pūrvapadasvaraḥ | baṃdhutā | banda*
> *baṃdhane | śūnyastvasnihītyādinā kartaryupratyayaḥ | samūha ityarthe grāmajanabaṃdhusahāyebhyastal | pā. 4-2-43 | iti tal | litsvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Ṛbhus, yours is the बंधुता (*baṃdhutā*). बंधवः (*baṃdhavaḥ*) are rites, because they bind, that is, join one to the fruit; their totality is बंधुता (*baṃdhutā*). It is known here and there, everywhere, by all in the mind. You, the नरः (*naraḥ*), men, Ṛbhus, उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*), desiring the sacrificial share, वेदसा (*vedasā*), with knowledge of the rites that obtain the sacrificial share, have approached तानि (*tāni*), such rites." Which are they? मायाभिः (*māyābhiḥ*): मायाः (*māyāḥ*) are rites, because they are "measured out", that is, known. By which rites the Saudhanvas were प्रतिजूतिवर्पसः (*pratijūtivarpasaḥ*), endowed with a splendour that overcomes opponents. Sudhanvan was a ṛṣi, son of Āṅgirasa; his sons are the Saudhanvas, and they are three: Ṛbhu, Vibhvan, Vāja. "You, so named, have obtained the यज्ञियं भागं (*yajñiyaṃ bhāgaṃ*), the share fit for sacrifice, consisting of Soma-drinking and the like." The mantra text says so: ऋभुर्विभ्वा वाजो देवा अगच्छत स्वपसो यज्ञियं भागमैतन (*ṛbhurvibhvā vājo devā agacchata svapaso yajñiyaṃ bhāgamaitana*) (Ṛgve. 1 161-6).[?216] The same meaning is stated clearly in the Brāhmaṇa too, with the story, in "the Ṛbhus among the gods won the Soma-drinking by austerity" (*abhavo vai deveṣu tapasā somapīthamabhyajayan*).[?217]

Or else: नरः (*naraḥ*) are leaders of rites, O Ṛbhus; उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*) are desirous; वेदसा (*vedasā*) means "endowed with wealth in the form of oblation". The praisers of you approach with the mind, as बंधुता (*baṃdhutā*), in kinship, friendship, those rites such as the fashioning of the chamasa. By which rites such as chamasa-fashioning you obtained the share fit for sacrifice, those (rites) they approach; the meaning is that they think of your skill of intellect.[?218] He then begins to say that इहेह (*iheha*) means "always".

(The remainder of the same bhāṣya is grammatical and is left to the Grammar section.) The doubling in इहेह (*iheha*) is stated; since the latter member is āmreḍita, it is anudātta, and the accent is that of the former word.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋभुगळे (*ṛbhugaḷe*)—O Ṛbhus
- वः (*vaḥ*)—your
- बंधुता (*baṃdhutā*)—skill in action
- इहेह (*iheha*)—in all regions
- मनसा (*manasā*)—is known[?219]
- नरः (*naraḥ*)—O Ṛbhus, men
- उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*)—you, who desired the sacrificial share
- वेदसा (*vedasā*)—(by knowledge of the nature of the rite that produces this qualification)
- तानि (*tāni*)—such excellent rites
- अभिजग्मुः (*abhijagmuḥ*)—you have created
- याभिः मायाभिः (*yābhiḥ māyābhiḥ*)—by which same extraordinary rites obtained
- प्रतिजूतिवर्पसः (*pratijūtivarpasaḥ*)—endowed with splendour that destroys enemies
- सौधन्वनाः (*saudhanvanāḥ*)—you, sons of Sudhanvan
- यज्ञियं भागं (*yajjiyaṃ bhāgaṃ*)—the Soma and the rest, fit for sacrifice
- आनश (*ānaśa*)—you have obtained

Gist

O Ṛbhus, your skill in action is known in all regions. O Ṛbhus, men, you who desired the sacrificial share, by knowledge of the rite that produces this qualification, have created such excellent rites. You, sons of Sudhanvan, endowed with the enemy-destroying splendour obtained by those same extraordinary rites, have obtained the Soma and the rest, fit for sacrifice.

English translation

Your connexion (with the consequence, of acts) Ribhus is here (acknowledged) by the minds of all : desiring their share (of the sacrifice), oh men, they have come with a knowledge (of their claims) to these (rites) : the sons of Sudhanvan, with the devices by which they are victorious over foes, you have accepted the share of the sacrifice.

Special Topics

आद्याश्चतस्रः पृष्ठाभिप्लवषडहयोः प्रथमेऽहनि वैश्वदेवशस्त्रे अर्भवनिविद्धानीयाः । (*ādyāścatasraḥ pṛṣṭhābhiplavaṣaḍahayoḥ prathame 'hani vaiśvadevaśastre arbhavanividdhānīyāḥ |*). The commentator indicates the rule that the first four mantras of this sūkta are to be recited, in the form of the Vaiśvadeva śastra, on the first day of the Pṛṣṭha and Abhiplava ṣaḍahas. Abhiplava and Pṛṣṭha are sacrifices of the nature of śastra and stotra, to be performed in the ṣaḍahas; their differences will be stated as the occasion arises. Here only their special character in the present context will be explained.

Abhiplava and Pṛṣṭha (continued from the preceding discussion of the introductory particulars):

अभिप्लवः षडहः स्वर्गस्य लोकस्याथ यथा महापथः पर्याण एवं पृष्ठः षळहः स्वर्गस्य लोकस्य । (*abhiplavaḥ ṣaḍahaḥ svargasya lokasyātha yathā mahāpathaḥ paryāṇa evaṃ pṛṣṭhaḥ ṣaḷahaḥ svargasya lokasya |*) (Ai. Brā. 4-17).

It is stated that the Abhiplava ṣaḍaha is the path that leads straight to heaven, while the Pṛṣṭha ṣaḍaha is the path that leads to the same heaven by a somewhat roundabout way. Yet both are declared to be principal means of reaching heaven. Of their details, the nature and greatness of the Abhiplava ṣaḍaha are given here; the procedures of the Pṛṣṭha ṣaḍaha and their greatness will be given later, as the occasion arises.

1. The reason for the names Abhiplava and Pṛṣṭha, and the characteristics the two have in common—

तआदित्याः । चतुर्भिः स्तोमैश्चतुर्भिः पृष्ठैर्लघुभिः सामभिः स्वर्गं लोकमभ्यप्लवंत यदभ्यप्लवंत तस्मादभिप्लवाः । (*taādityāḥ | caturbhiḥ stomaiścaturbhiḥ pṛṣṭhairlaghubhiḥ sāmabhiḥ svargaṃ lokamabhyaplavaṃta yadabhyaplavaṃta tasmādabhiplavāḥ |*) (Śa. Brā. 12-2-2-10).

The Ādityas crossed over to the world of heaven with the four Stomas, the four Pṛṣṭhas and the four light sāmans. Because they thus "crossed over" (abhiplava), this rite, which is the means of crossing, also came to be called Abhiplava.

अन्वंच इवांगिरसः । सर्वै स्तोमैः सर्वैः पृष्ठैर्गुरुभिः सामभिः स्वर्गं लोकमस्पृशन्यदस्पृशंस्तस्मात्पृष्टिः ॥ (*anvaṃca ivāṃgirasaḥ | sarvai stomaiḥ sarvaiḥ pṛṣṭairgurubhiḥ sāmabhiḥ svargaṃ lokamaspṛśanyadaspṛśaṃstasmātpṛṣṭiḥ ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 12-2-11).

The Aṅgirases touched the world of heaven with all the Stomas, all the Pṛṣṭhas and the heavy sāmans. Because this rite is the means of touching, it received the name Pṛṣṭha. Thus the characteristics of the two rites are stated.

तदाहुः । तस्मादुभयतो ज्योतिषोऽभिप्लवा भवंत्यन्यतो ज्योतिः पृष्ठि इतिमे वै लोका अभिप्लवा उभयतो ज्योतिषो वा इमे लोका अग्निनेत आदित्येनामुत ऋतवः पृष्ठोऽन्यतो ज्योतिषो वा ऋतव एष एषां ज्योतिर्य एष तपति ॥ (*tadāhuḥ | tasmādubhayato jyotiṣo 'bhiplavā bhavaṃtyanyato jyotiḥ pṛṣṭhi itime vai lokā abhiplavā ubhayato jyotiṣo vā ime lokā agnineta ādityenāmuta ṛtavaḥ pṛṣṭho 'nyato jyotiṣo vā ṛtava eṣa eṣāṃ jyotirya eṣa tapati ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 12-2-2-1).

The Abhiplava ṣaḍaha is luminous on both sides, whereas the Pṛṣṭha has light on one side only. If one asks the reason: the Abhiplava ṣaḍahas are none other than these worlds. Above these worlds, light streams from one side from the terrestrial fire and from the other side from the sun in the atmosphere.

The Pṛṣṭha ṣaḍahas, being of the nature of the seasons, can have light from one side only; they receive their brilliance only from the sun in the atmosphere.

देवचक्रे ना एते पृष्य प्रतिष्ठिते । यजमानस्य पाप्मानं तृगं्हितो परिप्लवेते स यो हैवं विमषां दीक्षितानां पापगं् सत्रे कीर्तयत्येते हास्य देवचक्रे (*devacakre nā ete pṛṣya pratiṣṭhite | yajamānasya pāpmānaṃ tṛgṃhito pariplavete sa yo haivaṃ vimaṣāṃ dīkṣitānāṃ pāpagṃ sattre kīrtayatyete hāsya devacakre*)

These Pṛṣṭha and the firmly established Abhiplava are two divine wheels. While they revolve, all the sins of the sacrificer are ground to pieces and destroyed. If anyone at the time of the sacrifice utters words disparaging them, his head is cut off. The dasarātra is the main seat of the chariot of the gods; the Pṛṣṭha and Abhiplava are the two wheels.

तदाहुः । यत्समे एव चक्रे भवतोऽथैते विषमास्तोमाः कथमस्यैते समाः स्तोमास्तोमा उपेता भवंतीति यदेव षडन्यान्यहानि षडन्यानि तेनेति ब्रूयात् ॥ (*tadāhuḥ | yatsame eva cakre bhavato 'thaite viṣamāstomāḥ kathamasyaite samāḥ stomāstomā upetā bhavaṃtīti yadeva ṣaḍanyānyahāni ṣaḍanyāni teneti brūyāt ‖*)

These two wheels are equal (similar in form, each being a ṣaḍaha), but the Stomas connected with them are not of equal form. If one asks how that is consistent, it is consistent if one says that each of them has six days of like character.

पृष्ठाभिप्लवौ तंत्रे कुर्वीतेति ह स्माह पैंग्यः । तयोः स्तोत्राणि च शस्त्राणि च संचारयेदिति स यत्संचारयति तस्मादिमे प्राणा नाना संत एकोतयः समानमूतिमनुसंचरंत्यथ यन्न संचारयेत्प्रमायुको यजमानः स्यादेष ह वै प्रमायुक्तो योऽंधो वा बधिरो वा ॥ (*pṛṣṭhābhiplavau taṃtre kurvīteti ha smāha paiṃgyaḥ | tayoḥ stotrāṇi ca śastrāṇi ca saṃcārayediti sa yatsaṃcārayati tasmādime prāṇā nānā saṃta ekotayaḥ samānamūtimanusaṃcaraṃtyatha yanna saṃcārayetpramāyuko yajamānaḥ syādeṣa ha vai pramāyukto yo 'ṃdho vā badhiro vā ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 12-2-2-4).

Pṛṣṭha and Abhiplava are to be made two tantras (systems), and both made to move along in the same manner. On that occasion, just as the vital airs, though flowing in different channels, move in one way and have one aim, so these too have a common aim. Otherwise it may cause the destruction of the sacrificer, or he becomes blind or deaf. In such ways the greatness of the two is extolled. And just as the Abhiplava is described as luminous in both directions, the same point is stated at greater length in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa as follows —

Jyotir gaur āyur iti stomebhir yanti, ayaṃ vai loko jyotir antarikṣaṃ gaur asau loka āyuḥ (Ai. Brā. 18-15).

Jyotiḥ, Gauḥ, Āyuḥ mean the Jyotiṣṭoma, Gostoma and Āyuṣṭoma. The Jyotiṣṭoma is the earth-world, the Gostoma the atmosphere and the Āyuṣṭoma the heaven-world. The same idea is stated in the Yajurveda, in the passage beginning "Jyotiṣṭomaṃ prathamam upayanti" and ending "amuṣminn eva loke pratitiṣṭhanti".

स एवैष उत्तरस्प्रहः । ज्योतिर्गौरायुरिति त्रीण्यहानि गौरायुर्ज्योतिरिति त्रीणि । अयं वै लोको ज्योतिरस्लो लोको ज्योतिस्ते एते ज्योतिषी उभयतः संलोकेते ॥ (*sa evaiṣa uttarasprahaḥ | jyotirgaurāyuriti trīṇyahāni gaurāyurjyotiriti trīṇi | ayaṃ vai loko jyotiraslo loko jyotiste ete jyotiṣī ubhayataḥ saṃlokete ‖*)

The order of the second group of the tryaha is this: Jyotiḥ, Gauḥ, Āyuḥ form one group; Gauḥ, Āyuḥ, Jyotiḥ the other. Again, both groups, each belonging to the three worlds and filled with light on both sides, are of the nature of a ṣaḍaha.

तैनेतेनोभयतो ज्योतिषा षळहेन यंति तद्यदेतेनोभयतो ज्योतिषा षळहेन यंत्यनयोरेव तल्लोकयोरुभयतः प्रतितिष्ठंतो यंत्यस्मिंश्च लोकेऽमुष्मिंश्चोभयोः । परियद्वा एतद्देवचक्रंयदभिप्लवः षळहस्तस्य यावभितोऽग्निष्टोमौ ता प्रधी ये चत्वारो मध्य उक्थास्तन्नभ्यं ॥ (*tainetenobhayato jyotiṣā ṣaḷahena yaṃti tadyadetenobhayato jyotiṣā ṣaḷahena yaṃtyanayoreva tallokayorubhayataḥ pratitiṣṭhaṃto yaṃtyasmiṃśca loke 'muṣmiṃścobhayoḥ | pariyadvā etaddevacakraṃ yadabhiplavaḥ ṣaḷahastasya yāvabhito 'gniṣṭomau tā pradhī ye catvāro madhya ukthāstannabhyaṃ ‖*) (Ai. Brā. 18-15).

They proceed with the six groups of the ṣaḍaha, luminous on both sides, finding support and foothold on both sides of these two worlds. The Abhiplava ṣaḍaha is a divine wheel, which revolves in a circle. Its two Agniṣṭomas are the rims; the four Ukthas in the middle are the naves. In such words the greatness of the Abhiplava is praised. It is said that during that Abhiplava, which is thus joined with light on both sides, the first four mantras of the present sūkta are to be recited. Regarding their application, the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa says:

इहेह वो मनसा बंधुता नर इत्यार्भवं यद्वा एति च प्रेति च तत्प्रथमस्याह्नो रूपं तद्यत्प्रीति सर्वमभविष्यत्पृष्यन्नेवास्माल्लोकाद्यजमाना इति तद्यदिहेह वो मनसा बंधुता नर इत्यार्भवं प्रथमेऽहनि शंसत्य यं वै लोक इहेहास्मिन्नेवैनांस्तल्लोके रमयति ॥ (*iheha vo manasā baṃdhutā nara ityārbhavaṃ yadvā eti ca preti ca tatprathamasyāhno rūpaṃ tadyatprīti sarvamabhaviṣyatpṛṣyannevāsmāllokādyajamānā iti tadyadiheha vo manasā baṃdhutā nara ityārbhavaṃ prathame 'hani śaṃsatya yaṃ vai loka ihehāsminnevaināṃstalloke ramayati ‖*) (Ai. Brā. 28-30).

Here "eti" and "preti" are forms of the first day. Therefore the mantra इहेह वो मनसा (*iheha vo manasā*), addressed to the Ṛbhus, is indicated as recited on the first day of the Pṛṣṭhya ṣaḍaha. What the Pṛṣṭhya ṣaḍaha is, and why praise of the Ṛbhus occurs in it, will be told later.

The present mantra also describes how the Ṛbhus, though human, looked upon the sacrificial share; how, to obtain that qualification, they performed excellent acts and attained divinity; and how they then obtained the Soma and other offerings fit for sacrifice. The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa tells the same in story form:

यभवो वै .... पर्यपिबत् ॥ (*yabhavo vai .... paryapibat ‖*) (Ai. Brā. 13-20).

The Ṛbhus, who were human, performed supernatural deeds by their superhuman power and, by their supreme power of austerity, became doers of divine works and attained divinity. Then they too wished to drink Soma with the gods. First they made the attempt at the morning pressing. Agni, the chief deity of the morning pressing, joined with his companions the Vasus, gave them no opportunity to drink Soma, rejected them and drove them off. Then they tried again at the midday pressing. Indra, the lord of the midday pressing, joined with the Rudras and drove them away. Again they tried at the third pressing. Then the Viśvedevas said harshly, "You have no right to drink Soma; you have no entry here," and sent them away. Seeing their distress, Prajāpati addressed Savitṛ: "These Ṛbhus are your pupils; you must drink Soma with them." Savitṛ agreed. Prajāpati too drank Soma together with them. This is the situation told in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa. Referring to this in the present Ṛk, Sāyaṇa says

आयमर्थो ब्राह्मणेऽपि “ ऋभवो वै ... . ” इत्यत्रोपाख्यानपूर्वकं स्पष्टमभिहितः । (*āyamartho brāhmaṇe 'pi “ ṛbhavo vai ... . ” ityatropākhyānapūrvakaṃ spaṣṭamabhihitaḥ* |), that is, this same meaning is clearly stated in the Brāhmaṇa too.

Bandhutā—बद्धंति फलेन संयोजयंतीति बंधवः कर्माणि । तेषां समूहः बंधुता । (*baddhaṃti phalena saṃyojayaṃtīti baṃdhavaḥ karmāṇi | teṣāṃ samūhaḥ baṃdhutā* |). Because they join all acts with their fruit, or join the doer with the fruit, the word bandhu means "act"; the group of such acts is called bandhutā. This meaning is given for this word only in the present Ṛk, as appropriate.

Varaḥ—मनुष्याः (*manuṣyāḥ*): "men", that is, those who were human (and attained divinity).?220

ऋभुर्विभ्वा वाज इति सुधन्वन आंगिरसस्य त्रयः पुत्रा बभूवुः । (नि. ११-१६) ते अतिशयवद्भिः कर्मभिर्देवत्त्वमीयुः । (*ṛbhurvibhvā vāja iti sudhanvana āṃgirasasya trayaḥ putrā babhūvuḥ | (ni. 11-16) te atiśayavadbhiḥ karmabhirdevattvamīyuḥ* |) (Ni. 11-16). Sudhanvan Āṅgirasa had three sons named Ṛbhu, Vibhu and Vāja. By exceedingly good acts they attained divinity. The Nirukta author explains that here, through association, all three are addressed together by the name of the eldest.

Yābhiḥ māyābhiḥ—The special senses of the word māyā were stated earlier in this same volume, in the special topics of the first Ṛk of sūkta 3-56. Here it means "by extraordinary acts".

Pratijūtivarpasaḥ—It is somewhat difficult to give the meaning of this epithet. Sāyaṇa explains प्रतिपक्षाभिभवनशीलतेजोयुक्ताः (*pratipakṣābhibhavanaśīlatejoyuktāḥ*): possessed of the power to confront and defeat enemies. The scholar Monier Williams, in his Sanskrit-English Dictionary, explains the word as "Assuming any form according to their will", that is, having the power to assume any form they wish. Both meanings can fit here. How? Jūti has two meanings, speed and power. Varpas ordinarily means radiant lustre; it may also mean "body". So it can mean the inner brilliance that destroys the enemy's power, or the brilliance of a body that changes as the mind resolves. Its special force will be explained in the special topics of the next Ṛk.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

याभि॒ः शची॑भिश्चम॒साँ अपिं॑शत॒ यया॑ धि॒या गामरि॑णीत॒ चर्म॑णः ।
येन॒ हरी॒ मन॑सा नि॒रत॑क्षत॒ तेन॑ देव॒त्वमृ॑भव॒ः समा॑नश ॥ २ ॥

> *yābhiḥ śacībhiścamasā~ apiṃśata yayā dhiyā gāmariṇīta carmaṇaḥ |*
> *yena harī manasā niratakṣata tena devatvamṛbhavaḥ samānaśa ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> याभिः । शचीभिः । चमसान् । अपिंशत । यया । धिया । गां । अरिणीत । चर्मणः ।
> येन । हरी इति । मनसा । निःऽअतक्षत । तेन । देवत्वं । यभवः । सम् । आनश ॥

> *yābhiḥ | śacībhiḥ | camasān | apiṃśata | yayā | dhiyā | gāṃ | ariṇīta | carmaṇaḥ |*
> *yena | harī iti | manasā | niḥ 'atakṣata | tena | devatvaṃ | yabhavaḥ | sam | ānaśa ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋभवो याभिः शचीभिः शक्तिभिश्चमसान् चतुरोऽपिंशत विभक्तवंतः स्थ । यया धिया प्रज्ञया गां मृतामरिणीत चर्मणः चर्मणा योजनात्पापितवंतः स्थ । येन मनसा प्रज्ञानेन हरी एतन्नामकाविंद्रस्याश्वै निरतक्षत नितरामकुरुत । तथायं मंत्रवर्णः । य इंद्राय वचोयुजा ततक्षुर्मनसा हरी । ऋग्वे. १–२०–२ । इति । तेन सर्वेणानेन कर्मणा देवत्वं यज्ञभागार्हत्वलक्षणं देवभावं समानश । सम्यक् प्राप्ताः स्थ ॥ अपिंशत । पिश अवयवे । तुदादिः । तस्य लजि मध्यमे रूपं । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । अरिणीत । री गतिरेषणयोः । क्रादिः । तस्य लजि रूपं । अत्रापि पूर्ववदनिघातः । निरतक्षत । तक्षू त्वक्षू तनूकरणे । लजि रूपं । पूर्ववदनिघाते तिङ् चोदात्तवतीति गतेर्निघातः। आडुदात्तः । आनश। अश्नोतेर्लिट रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *he ṛbhavo yābhiḥ śacībhiḥ śaktibhiścamasān caturo 'piṃśata vibhaktavaṃtaḥ stha |*
> *yayā dhiyā prajñayā gāṃ mṛtāmariṇīta carmaṇaḥ carmaṇā yojanātpāpitavaṃtaḥ*
> *stha | yena manasā prajñānena harī etannāmakāviṃdrasyāśvai nirataksata nitarāmakuruta |*
> *tathāyaṃ maṃtravarṇaḥ | ya iṃdrāya vacoyujā tatakṣurmanasā harī | ṛgve.*
> *1-20-2 | iti | tena sarvèṇānena karmaṇā devatvaṃ yajñabhāgārhatvalakṣaṇaṃ devabhāvaṃ*
> *samānaśa | samyak prāptāḥ stha ‖ apiṃśata | piśa avayave | tudādiḥ | tasya laji madhyame*
> *rūpaṃ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | ariṇīta | rī gatireṣaṇayoḥ | krādiḥ | tasya laji*
> *rūpaṃ | atrāpi pūrvavadanighātaḥ | niratakṣata | takṣū tvakṣū tanūkaraṇe | laji rūpaṃ |*
> *pūrvavadanighāte tiṅ codāttavatīti gaternighātaḥ| āḍudāttaḥ | ānaśa| aśnoterliṭa*
> *rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Ṛbhus, with what powers (śacī, *śaktibhiḥ*) you divided the four chamasa cups; with what insight (dhī, प्रज्ञया (*prajñayā*)) you made the dead cow (*gāṃ mṛtāṃ*) reach life by joining it with its skin; with what mind (प्रज्ञानेन (*prajñānena*)) you fashioned the two horses named Hari, those of Indra." He confirms the last point with a mantra text: य इंद्राय वचोयुजा ततक्षुर्मनसा हरी (*ya iṃdrāya vacoyujā tatakṣurmanasā harī*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-20-2). "By all this work you have fully attained divinity (देवत्वं (*devatvaṃ*))", the divine state characterised by fitness for a share in the sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋभवः (*ṛbhavaḥ*)—O Ṛbhus
- याभिः (*yābhiḥ*)—by which
- शचीभिः (*śacībhiḥ*)—powers
- चमसान् (*camasān*)—the chamasa vessels

- अपिंशत (*apiṃśata*)—you made into four parts
- यया धिया (*yayā dhiyā*)—by which insight
- गां (*gāṃ*)—the dead cow
- चर्मणः आरिणीत (*carmaṇaḥ āriṇīta*)—you made live by a covering of skin
- येन मनसा (*yena manasā*)—by which intellect
- हरी (*harī*)—Indra's horses
- निरतक्षत (*niratakṣata*)—you fashioned
- तेन (*tena*)—by all these abilities
- देवत्वं (*devatvaṃ*)—divinity fit for sacrifice
- समानश (*samānaśa*)—you have fully attained

Gist

O Ṛbhus, by the powers with which you made the chamasa vessels into four parts, by the insight with which you made the dead cow live through a covering of skin, by the intellect with which you fashioned Indra's horses: because you possess all these abilities, you have fully attained the divinity that is fit for sacrifice.

English translation

With those faculties by which you have divided the ladles ; with that intelligence wherewith you have covered the (dead) cow with skin; with that will by which you have fabricated the two horses (of Indra); with those (means), Ribhus, you have attained divinity.

Special Topics

All the points that were described in the 20th sūkta of the first maṇḍala of the Ṛksaṃhitā (Bhāga 3), where the skill in action of the Ṛbhus is praised, are described here as well. The purport of those descriptions was explained briefly there. Some points not mentioned there are explained here. To show that the statement that they made the one ladle (camasa) into four has a special meaning, the Bṛhaddevatā puts the matter thus:

सुधन्वन अंगिरसस्यासन्पुत्रास्त्रयः पुरा । (*sudhanvana aṃgirasasyāsanputrāstrayaḥ purā |*)

ऋभुर्विभ्वा च वाजश्च शिष्यास्त्वष्टुश्च तेऽभवन् ॥ ३-८३ ॥ (*ṛbhurvibhvā ca vājaśca śiṣyāstvaṣṭuśca te 'bhavan ‖ 3-83 ‖*)

In former times a man named Sudhanvan, a son of Aṅgiras, was a famous king. He had three sons, Ṛbhu, Vibhvan and Vāja. They were disciples of Tvaṣṭṛ.

शिक्षयामास तांस्त्वष्टा त्वाष्टं यत्कर्म किंचन । (*śikṣayāmāsa tāṃstvaṣṭā tvāṣṭaṃ yatkarma kiṃcana |*)

परिनिष्टितकर्माणो विश्वेदेवा उपाह्वयन् ॥ ३-८४ ॥ (*pariniṣṭitakarmāṇo viśvedevā upāhvayan ‖ 3-84 ‖*)

Tvaṣṭṛ, who was accomplished in every art and science, taught them also all those arts and sciences. Then the Viśvedevas, who were adept in those sciences, seeing them, expressed their intolerance out of jealousy. And declaring that the Ṛbhus could certainly never attain a status equal to their own, they drew them into a contest.

विश्वेषां ते ततश्चक्रुर्वाहनान्यायधानि तु । (*viśveṣāṃ te tataścakrurvāhanānyāyadhāni tu |*)

धेनुं सबर्दुघां चक्रुरमृतं सबरुच्यते ॥ ३-८५ ॥ (*dhenuṃ sabardughāṃ cakruramṛtaṃ sabarucyate ‖ 3-85 ‖*)

Then, in answer to that challenge, they created and gave the Viśvedevas vehicles and weapons that would please them. And they made a cow that gives immortality. The power that earns immortality is the thing famed by the name sabar.

बृहस्पतेरथाश्विभ्यां रथं दिव्यं त्रिवंधुरं । (*bṛhaspaterathāśvibhyāṃ rathaṃ divyaṃ trivaṃdhuraṃ |*)

इंद्राय च हरी देवप्रहितेनाग्निनापि यत् ॥ ३-८६ ॥ (*iṃdrāya ca harī devaprahitenāgnināpi yat ‖ 3-86 ‖*)

Next they made a chariot with three seats (trivandhura) for Bṛhaspati and also for the Aśvins. They made the (horses) that were indispensable for Indra, and, Agni having been sent to them by the gods, they honoured him fittingly and sent him back.

एकं चमसमित्युक्तेज्येष्ठ आहेत्यथो दिवि । (*ekaṃ camasamityukte jyeṣṭha āhetyatho divi |*)

उक्त्वा ततक्षुश्चमसान् यथोक्तं तेन हर्षिताः ॥ ३-८७ ॥ (*uktvā tatakṣuścamasān yathoktaṃ tena harṣitāḥ ‖ 3-87 ‖*)

Then they divided into four parts the single ladle (camasa) that had been made by Tvaṣṭṛ. Tvaṣṭṛ was delighted by it.

त्वष्टा च सविता चैव देवदेवः प्रजापतिः । (*tvaṣṭā ca savitā caiva devadevaḥ prajāpatiḥ |*)

सर्वान् देवान् समामंत्र्य अमृतत्त्वं दुदुश्च ते ॥ (*sarvān devān samāmaṃtrya amṛtattvaṃ duduśca te ‖*) (I-88)[?221]

Then Tvaṣṭṛ, Savitṛ and Prajāpati, the god of the gods, pleased with their skill, summoned all the gods and, with their gracious consent, granted them immortality.

तृतीयसवने तेषां तैस्तु भागः प्रकल्पितः । (*tṛtīyasavane teṣāṃ taistu bhāgaḥ prakalpitaḥ |*)

In the third pressing (savana) a share of the oblation along with the Viśvedevas has been fixed for them. Indra too drank Soma together with them. In this manner, praising their greatness, it is stated that the 20th sūkta of the first maṇḍala was recited addressed to them. In the present context one must examine what is meant by "with their skills they cut the ladles (camasa)".

उत त्यं चमसं नवं त्वष्टुर्देवस्य निष्कृतं । (*uta tyaṃ camasaṃ navaṃ tvaṣṭurdevasya niṣkṛtaṃ |*)

अकर्त चतुरः पुनः ॥ (*akarta caturaḥ punaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-28-6)

Here it is stated that this ladle is the vessel of Tvaṣṭṛ. And in another part of the Ṛksaṃhitā this same ladle and this occasion are described in another way. If the nature of that description is understood, it becomes clear what this ladle is and what is meant by making it into four parts.

तत्सपिता वोऽमृतत्वमासुवदगोह्यं यच्छ्रवयंत ऐतन । (*tatsapitā vo 'mṛtatvamāsuvadagohyaṃ yacchravayaṃta aitana |*)

त्यं चिच्चमसमसुरस्य भक्षणमेकं संतमकृणुता चतुर्वयं ॥ (*tyaṃ ciccamasamasurasya bhakṣaṇamekaṃ saṃtamakṛṇutā caturvayaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-3)

O Ṛbhus, when you approached Savitṛ, who is easily visible to all and cannot be concealed by anyone, and begged that you too should take part in drinking the Soma juice, the god Savitṛ granted you full divinity free from death. Therefore you have made into four that famous ladle made by Tvaṣṭṛ, the means for drinking the Soma juice, which at the time of its creation was created as one only.

From the above example the relation of the Āditya (the sun) to the creation of the world is shown, and the part of the Ṛbhus in it is indicated. There are many grounds for saying that what is described as असुरस्य भक्षणं । एकं संतं (*asurasya bhakṣaṇaṃ | ekaṃ saṃtaṃ*) (the vessel)

is nothing other than the orb of the sun. Before dividing as creation, these four principles, the sun, the moon, heaven (dyauḥ) and earth, were joined together as one original principle. As this unity is before creation, so it is also at the time of dissolution. In this context the description of two forms of truth should be seen. First, Savitṛ and his unconcealable camasa; or the camasa of the unconcealable Savitṛ. (चमस .... यस्मिन् यशो निहितं विश्वरूपं (*camasa .... yasmin yaśo nihitaṃ viśvarūpaṃ*) A. Ve. 10-8-9)[?222]. Second, the door of entry to truth, covered by the golden vessel (हिरण्ययेन पात्रेण सत्यस्यापिहितं मुखं (*hiraṇyayena pātreṇa satyasyāpihitaṃ mukhaṃ*) Īśa U. 15)[?223]. This golden vessel of the Āditya, known as the camasa, is itself the model for the sacrificial ladle, the camasa. Here one must understand what the original single principle is and what the nature of the four parts is.

The single-natured camasa of Tvaṣṭṛ is the Āditya; through this Āditya he keeps watching over and creating all the worlds that rest on Tvaṣṭṛ. That the Ṛbhus divided this one solar principle into four parts means this: dividing day and night, as he goes from east to west, east and west are two stations of the Āditya; and in the two divisions of the year, south and north (dakṣiṇāyana, uttarāyaṇa) are two stations. Thus the four stations of the sun are east, west, south and north. This is what the Pañcaviṃśabrāhmaṇa describes as चतस्रो दिशः (*catasro diśaḥ*) (15-3-25). It was said that the thunderbolt that, according to त्वष्टा यद्वज्रं सुकृते हिरण्मयं (*tvaṣṭā yadvajraṃ sukṛte* *hiraṇmayaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1.85-9), Tvaṣṭṛ gave to Indra is itself this vessel-form. It can be said, because it is stated that this same thunderbolt became four parts:

इंद्रो ह यत्र वृत्राय वज्रं प्रजहार । (*iṃdro ha yatra vṛtrāya vajraṃ prajahāra* |) स प्रहतश्चतुर्धाभवत् ॥ (*sa prahataścaturdhābhavat* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 1-2-4-1)

When Indra hurled at Vṛtra the thunderbolt given by Tvaṣṭṛ, it became fourfold. The account in such sentences shows that a thing that is one in its original form became four divisions in its effected form.

The Nirukta explanation also supports the purport stated above. Thus: उरु भांतीति वा ; ऋतेन भांतीति वा ; ऋतेन भवंतीति वा । (*uru bhāṃtīti vā ; ṛtena bhāṃtīti vā ; ṛtena bhavaṃtīti vā* |) The explanation of the Nirukta-author is that the name "Ṛbhus" is well known either as "those who shine abundantly", that is, "those who shine by truth", or as "those who shine by being (sattva) or power".

Extending this very sense, he has shown also that आदित्यरश्मयोऽप्यभव उच्यंते (*ādityaraśmayo 'pyabhava ucyaṃte*): the rays of the Āditya too are called Ṛbhus.

Therefore the solar principle is the basis of the distinctions "one" and "four". The orb of the Āditya in the causal state is undivided and expresses the one principle. In the effected state, when the solar principle moves through the rays and so on, it becomes the cause of the distinctions of time, place and the like. It would not be wrong to say, on the basis of the Vedic sentences cited above, that the principle of the rays that is the cause of these distinctions is the Ṛbhu-nature. There are still more Vedic sentences supporting this purport. Some of them state clearly the identity of the Ṛbhus with the rays of the Āditya. For example:

उद्वत्स्वस्मा आकृणोतना तृणं निवत्स्वपः स्वपस्यया नरः । (*udvatsvasmā ākṛṇotanā tṛṇaṃ nivatsvapaḥ svapasyayā naraḥ* |)

अगोह्यस्य यदसस्तना गृहे तदद्येदमृभवो नानु गच्छथ ॥ (*agohyasya yadasastanā gṛhe tadadyedamṛbhavo nānu gacchatha* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-161-11)

The Ṛbhus in the form of the sun's rays are the leaders of rain and all such things, the nourishers of rice and other plants, those who take shelter in the dwelling-place of the Āditya, and so on. Such descriptions can indicate nothing other than the rays of the Āditya. संमील्य यद्भवना पर्यसर्पत क्व स्वित्तात्या पितरा व आसतुः (*saṃmīlya yadbhavanā paryasarpata kva svittātyā pitarā va āsatuḥ*) (1-161-12) and many other sentences support this very purport. सौधन्वना ऋभवः सूरचक्षसः (*saudhanvanā ṛbhavaḥ sūracakṣasaḥ*) (1-110-4); तरणित्वा ये पितुरस्य सश्शिर ऋभवः । (*taraṇitvā ye piturasya saśśira ṛbhavaḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-6): such descriptions show the non-difference of the Āditya and the Ṛbhus. These very ones are the "sun-eyed"; they obtained their speed of movement from their father, the Āditya. Thus the Ṛbhus' relation to the Āditya and their solar nature are described.

क्व स्विदासां कतमा पुराणी यया विधाना विदधुर्य भूणां ॥ (*kva svidāsāṃ katamā purāṇī yayā vidhānā vidadhurya bhūṇāṃ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-51-6)

In this and the like, the revolving of the shining Uṣas-es is shown as helping the Ṛbhus' work of making the camasa and the rest; so the relation between Uṣas and the Ṛbhus, who are of the form of the Āditya's rays, is shown.

यया धिया - यया प्रज्ञया । (*yayā dhiyā - yayā prajñayā* |) "By what intelligence": thus the intelligence of the Ṛbhus is praised. Ordinarily, in such contexts the word dhī does not mean merely mental intellect but is understood as meditative insight. As the Upaniṣads and the like explain the word dhīra as one who has meditative intellect, so in the Ṛksaṃhitā too the word dhī points to meditation. For example:

द्विता होतारां मनुषश्च वाघतो धिया रथं न कुलिशः समृण्वति ॥ (*dvitā hotārāṃ manuṣaśca vāghato dhiyā rathaṃ na kuliśaḥ samṛṇvati* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-2-1)

In such passages the special sense of the word dhī is shown: they accomplished the praise of Agni and other deities through meditative acts. As in contexts such as चेतयध्वमिति, चितिमच्छतेति (*cetayadhvamiti, citimacchateti*) (Śa. Brā. 6-2-31) the word cetana is explained not as a mere mental state but as meditation, the same meaning must be given to the word dhī in the present case. The Upaniṣads and the like describe austerity (tapas) as the root of the works of creation and the rest. Here too, since the Ṛbhus are the doers of the work of creation, the purport is that they obtained the success of their work through insight in the form of meditation suited to that work.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑स्य स॒ख्यमृ॒भव॒ः समा॑नशु॒र्मनो॒र्नपा॑तो अ॒पसो॑ दधन्विरे ।
सौ॒ध॒न्व॒नासो॑ अमृत॒त्वमेरि॑रे वि॒ष्ट्वी शमी॑भिः सु॒कृत॑ः सुकृ॒त्यया॑ ॥ ३ ॥

> *indrasya sakhyamṛbhavaḥ samānaśurmanornapāto apaso dadhanvire |*
> *saudhanvanāso amṛtatvamerire viṣṭvī śamībhiḥ sukṛtaḥ sukṛtyayā ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रस्य । सख्यं । ऋभवः । सम् । आनशुः । मनोः । नपातः । अपसः । दधन्व रे ।
> सौधन्वनासः । अमृतत्वं । आ । ईरिरे । विष्ट्वी । शमीभिः । सुकृतः । सुकृत्यया ॥३॥

> *iṃdrasya | sakhyaṃ | ṛbhavaḥ | sam | ānaśuḥ | manoḥ | napātaḥ | apasaḥ | dadhanva re |*
> *saudhanvanāsaḥ | amṛtatvaṃ | ā | īrire | viṣṭvī | śamībhiḥ | sukṛtaḥ | sukṛtyayā ‖3‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मनोर्नपातो मनुष्यस्यांगिरसः पुत्रा अपसो यागादिलक्षणकर्मवंत
> ऋभव इंद्रस्य सख्यं समानख्यानत्वं समानशुः । सम्यक् प्राप्नुवन् । तथेंद्रस्य
> सख्यं प्राप्तास्त ऋभवो दधन्विरे । पूर्वं मनुष्यत्वेन मरणयोग्या अपीदानीमिंद्रस्य सख्येन
> प्राणान्धारयंति । तथा मंत्रः । आधारयंत वह्नयः ' ऋग्वे.
> १–२०–८। इति । सौधन्वनासः सुधन्वनामकस्यर्षेः पुत्रा ऋभवः सुकृतः शोभनकर्माणः
> संतः प्रभूतैः कमीभिर्देवत्वपाप्तिप्रतिबंधनिवारणहेतुभिः कर्मभिः सुकृत्यया
> शोभनेन कर्मणा च विष्ट्वी व्याप्यामृतत्वमेरिरे । देवत्वं प्रापुः । तथा च

> *manornapāto manuṣyasyāṃgirasaḥ putrā apaso*
> *yāgādilakṣaṇakarmavaṃta*
> *ṛbhava iṃdrasya sakhyaṃ samānakhyānatvaṃ samānaśuḥ | samyak*
> *prāpnuvan | tatheṃdrasya*
> *sakhyaṃ prāptāsta ṛbhavo dadhanvire | pūrvaṃ manuṣyatvena*
> *maraṇayogyā apīdānīmiṃdrasya sakhyena prāṇāndhārayaṃti | tathā*
> *maṃtraḥ | ādhārayaṃta vahnayaḥ ' ṛgve.*
> *1-20-8| iti | saudhanvanāsaḥ sudhanvanāmakasyarṣeḥ putrā ṛbhavaḥ*
> *sukṛtaḥ śobhanakarmāṇaḥ*
> *saṃtaḥ prabhūtaiḥ kamībhirdevatvapāptipratibaṃdhanivāraṇahetubhiḥ*
> *karmabhiḥ sukṛtyayā*
> *śobhanena karmaṇā ca viṣṭvī vyāpyāmṛtatvamerire | devatvaṃ prāpuḥ |*
> *tathā ca*

> मंत्रांतरमाव्नायते । मर्तासः संतो अमृतत्वमानशुः । ऋग्वे. १–११०–४ । इति॥
> नपातः । नभ्राण्नपादित्यादिना नञ्ञः प्रकृतिभावः । दधन्विरे । धनिर्गत्यर्थः ।
> व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । लिटि रूपं । ईरिरे । ईर गत् । मंत्रत्वादाम्न भवति । निघातः ।
> सुकृत्यया । करोतेर्भावे कृञ्ञः श चेति क्यप् । प्रत्ययस्य व्यत्ययेनांतोदात्तत्वं । समासे
> कृदुत्तरस्वरः ॥

> *maṃtrāṃtaramāvnāyate | martāsaḥ saṃto amṛtatvamānaśuḥ | ṛgve.*
> *1-110-4 | iti‖*
> *napātaḥ | nabhrāṇnapādityādinā naññaḥ prakṛtibhāvaḥ | dadhanvire |*
> *dhanirgatyarthaḥ | vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | liṭi rūpaṃ | īrire | īra gat*
> *| maṃtratvādāmna bhavati | nighātaḥ |*
> *sukṛtyayā | karoterbhāve kṛññaḥ śa ceti kyap | pratyayasya*
> *vyatyayenāṃtodāttatvaṃ | samāse kṛduttarasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

The Ṛbhus, "grandsons of Manu" (manor napātaḥ), are the sons of the man Aṅgiras, and are apasaḥ, that is, possessed of work such as sacrifice. They fully attained (समानशुः (*samānaśuḥ*), "rightly obtained") Indra's friendship, that is, equal renown. Having attained Indra's friendship, those Ṛbhus दधन्विरे (*dadhanvire*) (dadhanvire): though formerly, being human, liable to die, they now sustain their lives through Indra's friendship. So a mantra: आधारयंत वह्नयः (*ādhārayaṃta vahnayaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-20-8). The Saudhanvanas, the Ṛbhus, sons of the seer named Sudhanvan, being doers of good works, by abundant works that are the means of removing the obstacles to the attainment of godhood, and by good work, pervading (the world), attained immortality, that is, godhood. And so

Another mantra is handed down: मर्तासः संतो अमृतत्वमानशुः (*martāsaḥ saṃto amṛtatvamānaśuḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-4). The rest of the block treats the accent and formation of napātaḥ, dadhanvire, īrire and sukṛtyayā.

Word-to-word meaning

- मनोः (*manoḥ*)—of the human Aṅgiras
- नपातः (*napātaḥ*)—sons
- अपसः (*apasaḥ*)—performers of sacrifice and other works
- ऋभवः (*ṛbhavaḥ*)—the Ṛbhus
- इंद्रस्य (*iṃdrasya*)—of Indra
- सख्यं (*sakhyaṃ*)—friendship
- समानशुः (*samānaśuḥ*)—obtained, and
- दधन्विरे (*dadhanvire*)—also attained freedom from death
- सौधन्वनासः (*saudhanvanāsaḥ*)—the Ṛbhus, sons of Sudhanvan
- सुकृतः (*sukṛtaḥ*)—as excellent doers of works
- शमीभिः (*śamībhiḥ*)—by excellent works
- सुकृत्यया (*sukṛtyayā*)—by good conduct
- विष्ट्वी (*viṣṭvī*)—pervading everywhere
- अमृतत्वं (*amṛtatvaṃ*)—freedom from death
- एरिरे (*erire*)—obtained

Gist

The Ṛbhus, sons of the human Aṅgiras and doers of sacrifice and other works, obtained the friendship of Indra. And by that help they also attained freedom from death. The Ṛbhus, sons of Sudhanvan, as excellent doers of works, pervading everywhere through excellent knowledge of duty and through their dealings, obtained freedom from death.

English translation

The Ribhus, the performers of (good) works, the grandsons of a man, have attained the friendship of Indra : they have perpetuated (existence): the sons of Sudhanvan have attained immortality : performers of pious acts influencing (the result), through their devotion (they have attained divinity) by their works

Special Topics

The present Ṛk says that the Ṛbhus, sons of Aṅgiras, obtained Indra's friendship. It is also stated that the word manoḥ is a synonym for the human Aṅgiras. If manoḥ means Aṅgiras, then, to understand the relation between the Ṛbhus of the form of the Āditya's rays, described in the preceding Ṛk, and Aṅgiras, one must know the relation between the Āditya and Aṅgiras. Then, knowing the relation between Aṅgiras and Indra, one can understand the purport of the Ṛbhus' having cultivated the friendship of Indra, who has such a close relation.

The very form of the Āditya whom the Chāndogya and other texts praise as the udgītha is also Aṅgiras. How is this?

अथाधिदैवतं य एवासौ तपति तमद्गीथमुपासीतोद्यन्वा एष प्रजाभ्य उद्गायति । उद्यन्स्तमो भयमपहन्त्यपहंता ह वै भयस्य तमसो भवति य एवं वेद ॥ (*athādhidaivataṃ ya evāsau tapati tamadgīthamupāsītodyanvā eṣa prajābhya uddāyati | udyanstamo bhayamapahantyapahaṃtā ha vai bhayasya tamaso bhavati ya evaṃ veda* ‖) (Bhā. U. 1-3-1)[?224]

One should worship the luminous Āditya himself as the udgītha. As soon as he rises he sings for the creatures in a manner that gives them joy. He destroys darkness and fear. Therefore this Āditya is the essence of the life of living beings and the giver of their contentment. Because he is thus the essence of life, the udgītha in the form of the Āditya is itself called Aṅgiras. How?

तं हांगिरा उद्गीथमुपासां चक्र एतमु एवांगिरसं मन्यंतेऽंगानां यद्रसः ॥ (*taṃ hāṃgirā uddīthamupāsāṃ cakra etamu evāṃgirasaṃ manyaṃte 'ṃgānāṃ yadrasaḥ* ‖) (Bhā. U. 1-2-10)[?225]

The Aṅgirases worshipped the udgītha. If one asks the reason for their worshipping, it is that they themselves are of the nature of the udgītha. How? The udgītha is the essence (rasa) of the limbs. Therefore udgītha means Aṅgiras. The rays of the Āditya give essence to the limbs of living beings. Therefore the udgītha is of the nature of the Āditya and of the nature of Aṅgiras; so by this explanation non-difference between the Āditya and Aṅgiras has been stated. Then what is the relation between such an Aṅgiras and Indra? It was explained earlier, in the Special Topics on Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-100-4, how the epithet अंगिरोभिः अंगिरस्तमः (*aṃgirobhiḥ aṃgirastamaḥ*) shows Indra's Aṅgiras-nature. The meaning of the statement that Indra in the form of Aṅgiras caused the cows to be released is that Indra in the form of the Āditya split the mountain of the form of darkness and freed the cows of the form of rays.

अगच्छदु विप्रतमः सखीयन्नसूदयत्सु कृते गर्भमद्रिः । (*agacchadu vipratamaḥ sakhīyannasūdayatsu kṛte garbhamadriḥ |*)

ससान मर्यो युवभिर्मखस्यन्नथाभवदंगिराः सद्यो अर्चन् ॥ (*sasāna maryo yuvabhirmakhasyannathābhavadaṃgirāḥ sadyo arcan ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-31-7)

In Ṛks of this kind this point is stated clearly.

शमीभिः (*śamībhiḥ*)—This word is read among the names of works (Ni. 3-1). It means the various kinds of skilled works and sacrificial works described earlier.

विष्ट्वे (*viṣṭve*)—This word too is read among the names of works (Ni. 3-1). Sāyaṇa, explaining this word elsewhere, has said as follows. There too the two, viṣṭvī, śamī,

The Kannada commentary continues: because the two words are used in one and the same place, if the word शमी (*śamī*) means "action", the same meaning cannot be given to the word विष्ट्वि (*viṣṭvi*); another meaning must be given. So Sāyaṇa explains as follows:

विष्ट्वितृत्र न कर्मनाम । शमीत्यनेन पौनरुक्तप्रसंगात् । किं तर्हि । विषेर्वाप्त्यर्थस्य क्रियाशब्दोऽयं विष्ट्विति । विष्ट्वा व्याप्ता ॥ (*viṣṭvitṛtra na karmanāma | śamītyanena paunaruktaprasaṃgāt | kiṃ tarhi | viṣervāptyarthasya kriyāśabdo 'yaṃ viṣṭviti | viṣṭvā vyāptā ‖*)

Although the word is read among the names of actions, the word शमी (*śamī*) already denotes action, so there would be repetition. He therefore states that this word, formed from the root विष् (*viṣ*) in the sense of pervading, means "all-pervading".

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्रे॑ण याथ स॒रथं॑ सु॒ते सचाँ॒ अथो॒ वशा॑नां भवथा स॒ह श्रि॒या ।
न व॑ः प्रति॒मै सु॑कृ॒तानि॑ वाघत॒ः सौध॑न्वना ऋभवो वी॒र्या॑णि च ॥ ४ ॥

> *indreṇa yātha sarathaṃ sute sacā~ atho vaśānāṃ bhavathā saha śriyā |*
> *na vaḥ pratimai sukṛtāni vāghataḥ saudhanvanā ṛbhavo vīryāṇi ca ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रेण । याथ । सरथं । सुते । सचा । अथो इति । वशानां । भवथ । सह । श्रिया ।
> न । वः । प्रतिमै । सुकृतानि । वाघतः । सौधन्वनाः । ऋभवः । वीर्याणि । च ॥ ४ ॥

> *iṃdreṇa | yātha | sarathaṃ | sute | sacā | atho iti | vaśānāṃ |*
> *bhavatha | saha | śriyā |*
> *na | vaḥ | pratimai | sukṛtāni | vāghataḥ | saudhanvanāḥ | ṛbhavaḥ |*
> *vīryāṇi | ca ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋभवो यूयमिंद्रेण सचा सह सरथं समानमेकं रथमारुह्य
> सुतेऽभिषुतसोमवति यज्ञे याथ । गच्छथ । अथो अनंतरमिंद्रेण सहैकरथमारूढा यूयं वशानां
> । उश्यते काम्यते यजमानेन स्वर्गादिलक्षणं फलमेभिरिति वशा मनुष्याः । तेषां श्रिया
> स्तुतिहविरादिरूपया सह भवथ । हे सौधन्वनाः
> सुधन्वनः पुत्रा वाघतोऽमृतत्वादिलक्षणफलस्य वोढारो मेधाविनो वेति यास्कः।
> तादृशा हे ऋभवो वो युष्माकं सुकृतानि देवत्वस्य प्रापकाणि शोभनानि
> कर्माणि न प्रतिमै । प्रतिमातुमियत्तया परिच्छेत्तुं न केनापि शक्यानि । तथा
> वीर्याणि युष्माकं सामर्थ्यानि च नैव प्रतिमातुं शक्यानि ॥ वशानां । वश कांतौ ।

> *he ṛbhavo yūyamiṃdreṇa sacā saha sarathaṃ samānamekaṃ rathamāruhya*
> *sute 'bhiṣutasomavati yajñe yātha | gacchatha | atho*
> *anaṃtaramiṃdreṇa sahaikarathamārūḍhā yūyaṃ vaśānāṃ | uśyate*
> *kāmyate yajamānena svargādilakṣaṇaṃ phalamebhiriti vaśā manuṣyāḥ |*
> *teṣāṃ śriyā stutihavirādirūpayā saha bhavatha | he saudhanvanāḥ*
> *sudhanvanaḥ putrā vāghato 'mṛtatvādilakṣaṇaphalasya voḍhāro*
> *medhāvino veti yāskaḥ|*
> *tādṛśā he ṛbhavo vo yuṣmākaṃ sukṛtāni devatvasya prāpakāṇi śobhanāni*
> *karmāṇi na pratimai | pratimātumiyattayā paricchettuṃ na kenāpi śakyāni | tathā*
> *vīryāṇi yuṣmākaṃ sāmarthyāni ca naiva pratimātuṃ śakyāni ‖ vaśānāṃ | vaśa kāṃtau |*

> वशिरण्योरुपसंख्यानमिति करणेऽप्रत्ययः । प्रत्ययस्य पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ।
> वशाशब्दो बंध्यावचनश्चेदंतोदात्तो भवति । वशा मेषा अवसृष्टास
> आहुताः । ऋग्वे. १०–९१–१४ । इति । वः । युष्मच्छब्दस्य षष्ठीबहुवचने वसादेशः ।
> निघातः । प्रतिमै । माज् माने । विच् । प्रतिमाः प्रतिमानं । तस्य चतुर्थैकवचन
> आतो लोपश्चांदसः । एकादेशस्वरः ॥

> *vaśiraṇyorupasaṃkhyānamiti karaṇe 'pratyayaḥ | pratyayasya pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | vaśāśabdo*
> *baṃdhyāvacanaścedaṃtodātto bhavati | vaśā meṣā avasṛṣṭāsa*
> *āhutāḥ | ṛgve. 10-91-14 | iti | vaḥ | yuṣmacchabdasya ṣaṣṭhībahuvacane vasādeśaḥ |*
> *nighātaḥ | pratimai | māj māne | vic | pratimāḥ pratimānaṃ | tasya caturthaikavacana*
> *āto lopaścāṃdasaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Ṛbhus, mounting one common chariot together with Indra, you go to the sacrifice in which Soma has been pressed. Then, having mounted the same chariot as Indra, you are together with the वशानां (*vaśānāṃ*). The वशाः (*vaśāḥ*) are men: the sacrificer desires (उश्यते (*uśyate*)) through them the fruit marked by heaven and the like. You are together with their "splendour" (श्रिया (*śriyā*)), in the form of praise, oblations and the like. O Sudhanvan's sons, वाघतः (*vāghataḥ*) means, according to Yāska, bearers of the fruit marked by immortality, or the wise. Of such you, O Ṛbhus, the good deeds that bring godhood, the well-done actions, cannot be measured, that is, delimited as "so much", by anyone. Likewise your powers cannot be measured. The grammatical remarks on वशानां (*vaśānāṃ*) begin here and continue on the next page.

The remaining remarks are grammatical, on वशानां (*vaśānāṃ*), वः (*vaḥ*) and प्रतिमै (*pratimai*). Sāyaṇa also notes that when the word वशा (*vaśā*) means a barren cow it is accented on the last syllable, and he cites Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-91-14 for it.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Ṛbhus) इंद्रेण सचा (*iṃdreṇa sacā*)—with Indra
- सरथं (*sarathaṃ*)—mounting one and the same chariot
- सुते (*sute*)—to the sacrifice in which Soma has been pressed
- याथ (*yātha*)—come
- अथ (*atha*)—afterwards
- वशानां (*vaśānāṃ*)—belonging to men
- श्रिया सह (*śriyā saha*)—with the wealth of praise and the like
- भवथ (*bhavatha*)—join together
- सौधन्वनाः (*saudhanvanāḥ*)—sons of Sudhanvan
- वाघतः (*vāghataḥ*)—wise ones
- ऋभवः (*ṛbhavaḥ*)—O Ṛbhus
- वः (*vaḥ*)—your
- सुकृतानि (*sukṛtāni*)—auspicious deeds
- वीर्याणि च (*vīryāṇi ca*)—and heroic acts
- न प्रतिमै (*na pratimai*)—no one is able to measure

Gist

O Ṛbhus, mounting one and the same chariot with Indra, come to the sacrifice in which Soma has been pressed. Then join together with the wealth of praise and the like that belongs to men. O Ṛbhus, sons of Sudhanvan and wise ones, no one is able to measure your auspicious deeds or your heroic acts.

English translation

Go with Indra in his chariot when the libation is poured out, and be (welcomed) with honour by the (worshipper) desiring (your favour): Ribhus, sons of Sudhanwan, bestowers (of the rewards of pious acts), your virtuons deeds, your great faculties, are not to be measured.

Special Topics

वशानां (*vaśānāṃ*)—उश्यते काम्यते यजमानेन स्वर्गादिलक्षणं फलं एभिः इति वशाः मनुष्याः । (*uśyate kāmyate yajamānena svargādilakṣaṇaṃ phalaṃ ebhiḥ iti vaśāḥ manuṣyāḥ* |) Since fruits such as heaven are desired through sacrificial rites, men who show such a desire are well known by the name वशाः (*vaśāḥ*). The expressions वशा निवित् (*vaśā nivit*) and the like, specified in the Aitareya Āraṇyaka and other works, also indicate the same meaning. (Ai. Ā. 1-5-2)

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ ऋ॒भुभि॒र्वाज॑वद्भि॒ः समु॑क्षितं सु॒तं सोम॒मा वृ॑षस्वा॒ गभ॑स्त्योः ।
धि॒येषि॒तो म॑घवन्दा॒शुषो॑ गृ॒हे सौ॑धन्व॒नेभि॑ः स॒ह म॑त्स्वा॒ नृभि॑ः ॥ ५ ॥

> *indra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiḥ samukṣitaṃ sutaṃ somamā vṛṣasvā gabhastyoḥ |*
> *dhiyeṣito maghavandāśuṣo gṛhe saudhanvanebhiḥ saha matsvā nṛbhiḥ || 5 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । ऋभुभिः । वाजवत्भिः । सम्उक्षितं । सुतं । सोमं । आ । वृषस्व । गभस्तोः ।
> धिया । इषितः । मघवन् । दाशुषः । गृहे । सौधन्वनेभिः । सह । मत्स्वा । नृभिः ॥

> *iṃdra | ṛbhubhiḥ | vājavatbhiḥ | samukṣitaṃ | sutaṃ | somaṃ | ā |*
> *vṛṣasva |*
> *gabhastoḥ |*
> *dhiyā | iṣitaḥ | maghavan | dāśuṣaḥ | gṛhe | saudhanvanebhiḥ | saha |*
> *matsvā | nṛbhiḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आभिप्लविके पंचमेऽहनि वैश्वदेवशस्त्र इंद्र युभुभिरित्यार्भवस्तृचः । सूत्रितं
> च । धृतवती भुवनानामभिश्रियेंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिरिति तृचौ । आ. ७–७ । इति ॥
> आद्यस्तृतीयसवने होतुः प्रस्थितयाज्या । सूत्रितं च । इंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिः
> समुक्षितमिंद्रावरुणा सुतपाविमं सुतं । आ. ५–५ । इति ॥
> हे इंद्र वाजवद्धिः । वाजो नाम ऋभूणां भ्राता । यद्वा । वाजोऽन्नं
> तत्सहितैर्युभुभिः सहितस्तं समुक्षितं सम्यगद्भिः सिक्तं ग्रावभिः सुतं सोमं
> गभस्तोः । बप्पत्यदंत्याभ्यामन्नमिति गृह्णंति पदार्थानाभ्यामिति वा गभस्ती बाहू ।
> तयोर्बाह्वोरा वृषस्व । आक्षारय । ग्रहमुभाभ्यां बाहुभ्यां गृहीत्वा सोमं
> पिबेत्यर्थः । हे मघवन् हे इंद्र धिया स्तोत्ररूपेण कर्मणेषितः प्रेरितस्तं
> दाशुषो हविर्दत्तवतो यजमानस्य गृहे सौधन्वनेभिः सुधन्वनः पुत्रैर्नृभिर्मनुष्यैर्युभुभिः सह साकं
> मत्त्व । सोमपानेन हृष्टो भव ॥ समुक्षितं । उक्ष
> सेचने । कर्मणि क्तः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः स्वरः । नभस्तोः । भस
> भर्त्सनदीप्त्योरित्यस्माद्भसेर्गट्टेति सूत्रेण तिप्रत्ययो धातोर्गडागमश्च । यद्वा । गृह्णातेः
> पृषोदरादित्वादेवं नेयं । मत्त्व । मदि स्तुत्यादिषु । लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति
> विकरणस्य लुक् । निघातः ॥

> *ābhiplavike paṃcame 'hani vaiśvadevaśastra iṃdra*
> *yubhubhirityārbhavastṛrcaḥ | sūtritaṃ*
> *ca | dhṛtavatī bhuvanānāmabhiśriyeṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiriti tṛcau |*
> *ā. 7-7 | iti ‖*
> *ādyastṛtīyasavane hotuḥ prasthitayājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | iṃdra*
> *ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiḥ*
> *samukṣitamiṃdrāvaruṇā sutapāvimaṃ sutaṃ | ā. 5-5 | iti ‖*
> *he iṃdra vājavaddhiḥ | vājo nāma ṛbhūṇāṃ bhrātā | yadvā | vājo 'nnaṃ*
> *tatsahitairyubhubhiḥ sahitastaṃ samukṣitaṃ samyagadbhiḥ siktaṃ*
> *grāvabhiḥ sutaṃ somaṃ*
> *gabhastoḥ | bappatyadaṃtyābhyāmannamiti gṛhṇaṃti*
> *padārthānābhyāmiti vā gabhastī bāhū |*
> *tayorbāhvorā vṛṣasva | ākṣāraya | grahamubhābhyāṃ bāhubhyāṃ*
> *gṛhītvā somaṃ*

> *pibetyarthaḥ | he maghavan he iṃdra dhiyā stotrarūpeṇa karmaṇeṣitaḥ preritastaṃ*
> *dāśuṣo havirdattavato yajamānasya gṛhe saudhanvanebhiḥ*
> *sudhanvanaḥ putrairnṛbhirmanuṣyairyubhubhiḥ saha sākaṃ mattva |*
> *somapānena hṛṣṭo bhava ‖ samukṣitaṃ | ukṣa*
> *secane | karmaṇi ktaḥ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ svaraḥ | nabhastoḥ |*
> *bhasa bhartsanadīpyorityasmādbhasergaṭṭeti sūtreṇa tipratyayo*
> *dhātorgaḍāgamaśca | yadvā | gṛhṇāteḥ*
> *pṛṣodarāditvādevaṃ neyaṃ | mattva | madi stutyādiṣu | loṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti*
> *vikaraṇasya luk | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

On the fifth day of the Ābhiplavika, in the Vaiśvadeva-śastra, the three verses beginning इंद्र ऋभुभिः (*iṃdra ṛbhubhiḥ*) form the Ṛbhu tṛca. This is stated in the sūtra: धृतवती भुवनानामभिश्रियेंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिरिति तृचौ (*dhṛtavatī bhuvanānāmabhiśriyeṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiriti tṛcau*) (Ā. 7-7). The first verse is also the prasthita-yājyā of the hotṛ at the third pressing, as the sūtra says: इंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिः समुक्षितमिंद्रावरुणा सुतपाविमं सुतं (*iṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiḥ samukṣitamiṃdrāvaruṇā sutapāvimaṃ sutaṃ*) (Ā. 5-5).

O Indra, accompanied by the वाजवद्भिः (*vājavaddhiḥ*) Ṛbhus. Vāja is the name of the brother of the Ṛbhus. Or else vāja is food, and the Ṛbhus are those who have it. Drink the Soma that has been sprinkled with water and pressed with the stones. गभस्तोः (*gabhastoḥ*): the two arms are called गभस्ती (*gabhastī*), either because with them people take (गृह्णंति (*gṛhṇaṃti*)) food after chewing, or because they take hold of objects. आ वृषस्व (*ā vṛṣasva*) means "pour in". The sense is: take the cup with both arms and drink the Soma. O Maghavan, O Indra, urged by the act of praise, rejoice in the house of the sacrificer who has given the oblation, together with the Ṛbhus, the sons of Sudhanvan, the men; become gladdened by drinking Soma. The rest is grammatical, on समुक्षितं (*samukṣitaṃ*), गभस्तोः (*gabhastoḥ*) and मत्त्व (*mattva*).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजवद्भिः (*vājavadbhiḥ*)—possessed of food
- ऋभुभिः (*ṛbhubhiḥ*)—together with the Ṛbhus
- समुक्षितं (*samukṣitaṃ*)—mixed with water
- सुतं (*sutaṃ*)—pressed with the pressing stones
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- गभस्त्योः (*gabhastyoḥ*)—lifting it with both arms
- आ वृषस्व (*ā vṛṣasva*)—drink
- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- धिया (*dhiyā*)—by the act in the form of praise
- इषितः (*iṣitaḥ*)—you who are urged
- दाशुषः (*dāśuṣaḥ*)—of the sacrificer who offers the oblation
- गृहे (*gṛhe*)—in the house
- सौधन्वनेभिः (*saudhanvanebhiḥ*)—sons of Sudhanvan
- नृभिः सह (*nṛbhiḥ saha*)—with the Ṛbhus who have the form of men
- मत्स्य (*matsya*)—drink Soma and become satisfied

Gist

O Indra, together with the Ṛbhus who are possessed of food, lift with both arms the Soma that has been soaked in water and crushed and pressed with stones, and drink it. O wealthy Indra, urged by the act in the form of praise, drink Soma in the house of the sacrificer who offers the oblation, together with the Ṛbhus, sons of Sudhanvan, who have the form of men, and become satisfied.

English translation

Indra, along with the food-bestowing Ribhus, accept with both hands the (cup of the) effused Soma libation ; excited Maghavan, by worship, rejoice with the human sons of Sudhanwan in the dwelling of the donor (of the offering).

Special Topics

On the fifth day of the sacrifice called Abhiplava, when the Vaiśvadeva-śastra mantras are recited, the three verses of this sūkta beginning इंद्र ऋभुभिः (*iṃdra ṛbhubhiḥ*) are to be recited as a tṛca addressed to the Ṛbhus. This is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra धृतवती भुवनानामभिश्रियेंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिरिति तृचौ (*dhṛtavatī bhuvanānāmabhiśriyeṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiriti tṛcau*) (Ā. 7-7). And the first verse of this sūkta is to be recited by the hotṛ at the third pressing as the prasthita-yājyā mantra; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana sūtra इंद्र ऋभुभिर्वाजवद्भिः समुक्षितमिंद्रावरुणा सुतपाविमं सुतं (*iṃdra ṛbhubhirvājavadbhiḥ samukṣitamiṃdrāvaruṇā sutapāvimaṃ sutaṃ*) (Ā. 5-5).

The injunction is stated that the present mantra and the one after it are to be recited in the form of the Vaiśvadeva-śastra. In both these mantras Indra is prayed to drink Soma together with the Ṛbhus; they are also in the form of the Ārbhava-pavamāna stotra. How it got the name Ārbhava-pavamāna is explained at length in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 15, in the account of the third pressing.

Special Topics

(continued)

गभस्तोः (*gabhastoḥ*)—The word गभस्ति (*gabhasti*) is read among the names of rays. In many places it is also used in the sense of "hand". In places where this word occurs, Sāyaṇa himself has explained it in some as "ray" and in some as "hand". For example, in वाचस्पतये पवस्वेति वृष्णोऽगं्शुभ्यां गभस्ति पूत इति (*vācaspataye pavasveti vṛṣṇo 'gṃśubhyāṃ gabhasti pūta iti*) (Śa. Brā. 4-9-1-9), गभस्तिपूतः (*gabhastipūtaḥ*) is explained as हस्ताभ्यां पूतः (*hastābhyāṃ pūtaḥ*). But when the same sentence occurs in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, he explains it as "purified by the rays of the sun" (Tai. Saṃ. 1-4-2). Again, in the same Taittirīya Saṃhitā, in the sentence at 6-4-5, गभस्तिना हि एनं पावयति (*gabhastinā hi enaṃ pāvayati*), he explains it as "hand". Although by usage the meaning "ray of the sun" predominates for the word गभस्ति (*gabhasti*), in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā too it is explained as "hand" in many places.

गभस्तिपूतं भरत श्रुतायेंद्राय सोमं यज्यवो जुहोत । (*gabhastipūtaṃ bharata śrutāyeṃdrāya somaṃ yajyavo juhota* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-14-8): here गभस्तिपूत (*gabhastipūta*) means "purified by the hands": offer the Soma to Indra. And in गभस्तिपूतो नृभिरद्रिभिः सुतो महे वाजाय धन्याय धन्वसि । (*gabhastipūto nṛbhiradribhiḥ suto mahe vājāya dhanyāya dhanvasi* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-86-34) also, the meaning "hand" is established. In the present verse Indra is prayed to lift the Soma with both गभस्ति (*gabhasti*), that is, with both arms, and drink it.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ ऋभु॒मान्वाज॑वान्मत्स्वे॒ह नो॒ऽस्मिन्सव॑ने॒ शच्या॑ पु
रुष्टुत ।
इ॒मानि॒ तुभ्यं॒ स्वस॑राणि येमिरे व्र॒ता दे॒वानां॒ मनु॑ष
श्च॒ धर्म॑भिः ॥ ६ ॥

> *indra ṛbhumānvājavānmatsveha no 'sminsavane śacyā puruṣṭuta |*
> *imāni tubhyaṃ svasarāṇi yemire vratā devānāṃ manuṣaśca dharmabhiḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । ऋभुमान् । वाजवान् । मत्स्व । इह । नः । अस्मिन् । सवने । शच्या ।
> पुरुस्तुत ।
> इमानि । तुभ्यं । स्वसराणि । येमिरे । व्रता । देवानां । मनुष्यः । च । धर्मभिः ॥

> *iṃdra | ṛbhumān | vājavān | matsva | iha | naḥ | asmin | savane | śacyā |*
> *purustuta |*
> *imāni | tubhyaṃ | svasarāṇi | yemire | vratā | devānāṃ | manuṣyaḥ | ca | dharmabhiḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पुरुष्टुत बहुभिः स्तुत हे इंद्र ऋभुमान् ऋभुणा तद्वान् वाजवान्
> वाजेन ऋभोर्भ्रात्रा युक्तः शच्येंद्राण्या कर्मणा वा सहितः सन् नोऽस्माकमिह
> कर्मण्यस्मिन् तृतीयसवने मत्स्य । हृष्टो भव । हे इंद्र शुभ्यं त्वदर्थमिमानि
> स्वसराण्यहानि येमिरे । तव सोमपानार्थं त्रिषु सवनेषु नियतान्यासते । किंच
> देवानामग्न्यादीनां व्रता व्रतानि कर्माणि च मनुषो मनुष्यस्य धर्मभिः कर्मभिः
> साकं त्वदर्थं नियतान्यासते॥

> *puruṣṭuta bahubhiḥ stuta he iṃdra ṛbhumān ṛbhuṇā tadvān vājavān*
> *vājena ṛbhorbhrātrā yuktaḥ śacyeṃdrāṇyā karmaṇā vā sahitaḥ san no 'smākamiha*
> *karmaṇyasmin tṛtīyasavane matsya | hṛṣṭo bhava | he iṃdra śubhyaṃ tvadarthamimāni*
> *svasarāṇyahāni yemire | tava somapānārthaṃ triṣu savaneṣu niyatānyāsate | kiṃca*
> *devānāmagnyādīnāṃ vratā vratāni karmāṇi ca manuṣo manuṣyasya dharmabhiḥ karmabhiḥ*
> *sākaṃ tvadarthaṃ niyatānyāsate||*

Summary

O Indra, praised by many (पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)), ऋभुमान् (*ṛbhumān*) is one having the Ṛbhu; वाजवान् (*vājavān*) is one joined with Vāja, the brother of Ṛbhu. Accompanied by शच्या (*śacyā*), that is, Indrāṇī or the act, be gladdened at this third pressing of ours in this rite. O Indra, these स्वसराणि (*svasarāṇi*), the days, are fixed (येमिरे (*yemire*)) for you; they remain appointed for your Soma-drinking in the three pressings. Moreover the व्रता (*vratā*), the rites and actions, of the gods Agni and the rest, together with the धर्मभिः (*dharmabhiḥ*), the actions, of man (मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)), remain appointed for you.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुष्टुत (*puruṣṭuta*)—praised by many
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- ऋभुमान् (*ṛbhumān*)—joined with Ṛbhu
- वाजवान् (*vājavān*)—joined with Vāja
- शच्या (*śacyā*)—joined with Indrāṇī

- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- इह (*iha*)—in this, a part of the rite
- अस्मिन् (*asmin*)—in the third pressing
- मत्स्य (*matsya*)—obtain satisfaction
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—for your satisfaction
- इमानि स्वसराणि (*imāni svasarāṇi*)—these days
- येमिरे (*yemire*)—move in a fixed course and recur?226
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the other gods
- व्रता च (*vratā ca*)—the rites also
- मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)—of man
- धर्मभिः (*dharmabhiḥ*)—together with the actions (are performed for your satisfaction)

Gist

O Indra, praised by many, being joined with Ṛbhu, with Vāja and with Śacī, be satisfied at this third pressing, which is a part of our rite. For your satisfaction these days move in a fixed course and recur. The rites of the other gods too, joined with the actions of man, are performed for your satisfaction.

English translation

Indra, the praised of many associated with Ribhu, and with Vaja, exult with Shachi, at this our sacrifice: these self-revolving (days) are devoted to you, as well as the ceremonies (addressed) to the gods, and the virtuous acts of man.

Special Topics

शच्या—इंद्राण्या कर्मणा वा । (*śacyā—iṃdrāṇyā karmaṇā vā* |) It is explained as "with Indrāṇī or with action". In the Nighaṇṭu the word शची (*śacī*) is read among the names of speech (Ni. 1-11), among the names of actions (Ni. 2-1) and among the names of intelligence (3-9). In general it is used mostly in the sense of action. The meaning "wife of Indra" for the word शची (*śacī*) is not supported in the Ṛgveda—

(continuation of the Special Topics of Ṛk 6)

In passages such as तुभ्यं श्चोतंत्यध्रिगो शचीव स्तोकासो अग्ने (*tubhyaṃ ścotaṃtyadhrigo śacīva stokāso agne*) (Ai. Brā. 2-12), the word शचीवः (*śacīvaḥ*) is explained as "possessed of power" (śaktimān). Addressing Agni, "O powerful Agni", the word शची (*śacī*) is taken to mean power. In the present Ṛk, whichever of the meanings power, action or intelligence is given, it is suitable. Since Indra is the doer of deeds such as the slaying of Vṛtra, since he has obtained manifold powers, and since he is endowed with intelligence, any of these meanings can be given to this word, which is an epithet of Indra.

स्वसराणि (*svasarāṇi*)—the word स्वर (*svara*) is read among the names for "worthy" (Ni. 1-9) and among the names for "house" (Ni. 3-4). In Ṛks such as आ हंसासो न स्वसराणि गंतन मधोर्मदाय मरुतः समन्यवः । (*ā haṃsāso na svasarāṇi gaṃtana madhormadāya marutaḥ samanyavaḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-34-5) it is explained as "house". In the present Ṛk it means "days".

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॑ ऋ॒भुभि॑र्वा॒जिभि॑र्वा॒जयं॑न्नि॒ह स्तोमं॑ जरि॒तुरुपं॑ याहि य॒ज्ञियं॑म् ।
श॒तं केतें॑भिरिषि॒रेभिं॑रा॒यवें॑ स॒हस्रं॑णीथो अध्व॒रस्य॒ होमं॑नि ॥ ७ ॥

> *indra ṛbhubhirvājibhirvājayanniha stomaṃ jariturupa yāhi yajñiyam |*
> *śataṃ ketebhiriṣirebhirāyave sahasraṇītho adhvarasya homani ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्र । ऋभुभिः । वाजिभिः । वाजयन् । इह । स्तोमं । जरितुः । उप । याहि ।
> यज्ञियं ।
> शतं । केतेभिः । इषिरेभिः । आयवे । सहस्रणीथः । अध्वरस्य । होमनि ॥ ७ ॥

> *iṃdra | ṛbhubhiḥ | vājibhiḥ | vājayan | iha | stomaṃ | jarituḥ | upa |*
> *yāhi |*
> *yajñiyaṃ |*
> *śataṃ | ketebhiḥ | iṣirebhiḥ | āyave | sahasraṇīthaḥ | adhvarasya |*
> *homani ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र वाजिभिर्वाजयुक्तैर्य्यभुभिः सहितस्त्वं वाजयन् स्तोतुर्वाजमन्नं कुर्वाण इह यज्ञे यज्ञियं
> यज्ञार्हं जरितु: स्तोमं स्तोत्रमुप

> *he iṃdra vājibhirvājayuktairyyabhubhiḥ sahitastvaṃ vājayan*
> *stoturvājamannaṃ kurvāṇa iha yajñe yajñiyaṃ yajñārhaṃ jaritu: stomaṃ*
> *stotramupa*

> याहि । आगच्छ । पुनः किंविशिष्टः । केतेभिः । केत्यते ज्ञायते सर्वमेभिरिति केताः
> प्राज्ञा मरुतः । तैः शतं शतसंख्याकैरिषिरेभिरिषिरैर्गमनकुशलैरश्वैः सहित आयवे
> मनुष्याय यजमानाय सहस्रनीथो बहुप्रकारनयनोपेतोऽध्वरस्य । न विद्यते
> द्वरो हिंसा यस्य तादृशस्य सोमस्य होमनि होम आगच्छेति शेषः ॥ वाजयन् ।
> वाजं करोतीति णिच् । णाविष्ठवदितीष्टवद्भावात्तुरिष्ठेमेयःस्थिति टिलोपः ।
> केतेभिः । कित ज्ञाने । घञ् । इंताद्वाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *yāhi | āgaccha | punaḥ kiṃviśiṣṭaḥ | ketebhiḥ | ketyate jñāyate*
> *sarvamebhiriti ketāḥ*
> *prājñā marutaḥ | taiḥ śataṃ*
> *śatasaṃkhyākairiṣirebhiriṣirairgamanakuśalairaśvaiḥ sahita āyave*
> *manuṣyāya yajamānāya sahasranītho bahuprakāranayanopeto*
> *'dhvarasya | na vidyate*
> *dvaro hiṃsā yasya tādṛśasya somasya homani homa āgaccheti śeṣaḥ ‖*
> *vājayan |*
> *vājaṃ karotīti ṇic | ṇāviṣṭhavaditīṣṭavadbhāvātturiṣṭhemeyaḥsthiti*
> *ṭilopaḥ |*
> *ketebhiḥ | kita jñāne | ghañ | iṃtādvādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, accompanied by the Ribhus, who are possessed of food (वाज (*vāja*)), making food for the singer, come here to this sacrifice, to the praise (stoma) of the singer, which is worthy of the sacrifice. (The sentence continues on the next page.)

"Come." And how is he accompanied? केतेभिः (*ketebhiḥ*): those by whom everything is known (केत्यते ज्ञायते (*ketyate jñāyate*)) are केताः (*ketāḥ*), the wise Maruts. With them, and with a hundred swift horses skilled in going (इषिरेभिः (*iṣirebhiḥ*)), Indra, "leader of a thousand" (सहस्रनीथः (*sahasranīthaḥ*)), that is, bringing many kinds of guidance, is to come for the man, the sacrificer (आयवे (*āyave*)), to the oblation of the Soma that is अध्वर (*adhvara*), to which no harm (dvara) belongs. "Come" is the word to be supplied. Then follow the derivations of वाजयन् (*vājayan*) and केतेभिः (*ketebhiḥ*) (grammar not given here).

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- वाजिभिः (*vājibhiḥ*)—endowed with food
- ऋभुभिः (*ṛbhubhiḥ*)—together with the Ribhus
- वाजयन् (*vājayan*)—producing the food needed by the praiser
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrifice
- जरितुः (*jarituḥ*)—of the praiser
- यज्ञियं (*yajjiyaṃ*)—worthy of sacrifice
- स्तोमं (*stomaṃ*)—towards the praise
- उप याहि (*upa yāhi*)—become one who comes
- केतेभिः (*ketebhiḥ*)—with the wise Maruts
- शतं इषिरेभिः (*śataṃ iṣirebhiḥ*)—and with a hundred horses, being joined with them
- आयती (*āyatī*)—for man (the sacrificer)[?227]
- सहस्रनीथः (*sahasranīthaḥ*)—taking food of many kinds
- अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)—of the Soma free of harm
- होमनि (*homani*)—be present at the oblation

Gist

O Indra, together with the Ribhus who are possessed of fire[?228], producing the food needed by the praiser, come in this sacrifice towards the praiser's praise, which is worthy of sacrifice. Joined with the wise Maruts and with a hundred horses, taking food of many kinds for the sacrificer, the man, be present at the oblation of the harmless Soma.

English translation

Indra, with the food-bestowing Ribhus rewarding (worship) with food, come hither to (receive) the reverential praise of the adorer, with a hundred quick-going steeds, the indications (of the Maruts): come to the burnt offering of the sacrifice, yielding a thousand blessings to the sacrificer.

Special Topics

The present mantra tells of the relation between Indra and the Ribhus and of their nature as givers of food. On the relation of Indra and the Ribhus, on the doubt that arose concerning the oblation offered to them, and on what the Ārbhava-pavamāna is, details are given in the description of the third pressing (tṛtīya-savana) in Ṛ. Saṃ., Part 15.

वाजयन् (*vājayan*)—स्तोतुः अन्नं कुर्वाणः (*stotuḥ annaṃ kurvāṇaḥ*), that is, procuring and giving food to the praiser. The word वाजिभिः (*vājibhiḥ*) too is explained as "endowed with food" (said of the Ribhus). वाजयतीत्यर्चतिकर्मा (*vājayatītyarcatikarmā*) (Ni. 3-19): in some contexts वाजयति (*vājayati*) must mean "one who worships". Moreover the word वाज (*vāja*) is read among the names for food (Ni. 3-9), among the names for battle and among the names for strength. It is also used in the sense of praise. In मां नरः स्वश्वा वाजयंतो मां वृताः समरणे हवंते । (*māṃ naraḥ svaśvā vājayaṃto māṃ vṛtāḥ samaraṇe havaṃte* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-42-5) the word वाजयंतः (*vājayaṃtaḥ*) is an epithet of नरः (*naraḥ*) and अश्वाः (*aśvāḥ*); it is explained as men and horses desiring battle. In passages such as स मातरा विचरन्वाजयन्नपः प्र मेधिरः स्वधया पिन्वते पदं । (*sa mātarā vicaranvājayannapaḥ pra medhiraḥ svadhayā pinvate padaṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-68-4) it also means "impelling". But the word वाज (*vāja*) is mostly used in the senses of food and strength. In the present Ṛk it is explained as "producing food".

That when Indra joins the Ribhus the abundance of वाज (*vāja*) becomes greater is well known from the Śruti. That the Ribhus are makers of fire is also described in many places. A fixed association of food with them is stated. For example, in विदानासो जन्मनो वाजरत्ना उत ऋतुभिर्यभवो मादयःध्वं । (*vidānāso janmano vājaratnā uta ṛtubhiryabhavo mādayaḥdhvaṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-34-2) the word वाजरत्नाः (*vājaratnāḥ*) is explained अन्नेन राजमानाः (*annena rājamānāḥ*), "the Ribhus shining with food", showing that the Ribhus are constantly endowed with food. The same point is made in the present Ṛk, and food is asked of them and of their friend Indra.

केतेभिः (*ketebhiḥ*)—केत्यते ज्ञायते सर्वमेभिरिति केताः प्राज्ञाः मरुतः (*ketyate jñāyate sarvamebhiriti ketāḥ prājñāḥ marutaḥ*). Because everything is known through them, the Maruts, having such a quality, are called केताः (*ketāḥ*). The meaning is: joined with such Maruts.

Sūkta 61 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> उषो वाजेनेति सप्तर्चमष्टमं सूक्तं वैश्वामित्रमुषोदेवताकं । तथा
> चानुक्रांतं । उष उषस्यमिति ॥ प्रातरनुवाक उषस्यॆ क्रतावाश्विनशस्त्रे च त्रैष्टुभे
> छंदस्येतस्य सूक्तस्य विनियोगः । सूत्रितं च । उषो वाजेनेदमु त्यत । आ. ४–१४ ।
> इति ॥

> *uṣo vājeneti saptarcamaṣṭamaṃ sūktaṃ vaiśvāmitramuṣodevatākaṃ | tathā*
> *cānukrāṃtaṃ | uṣa uṣasyamiti ‖ prātaranuvāka uṣasyè kratāvāśvinaśastre ca traiṣṭubhe*
> *chaṃdasyetasya sūktasya viniyogaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | uṣo vājenedamu tyata | ā. 4-14 |*
> *iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta उषो वाजेन (*uṣo vājena*) has seven Ṛks; it is the eighth sūkta (of the anuvāka) of Viśvāmitra, with Uṣas as deity. So the Anukramaṇī: उष उषस्यमिति (*uṣa uṣasyamiti*). Its use: in the Prātaranuvāka, in the Uṣasya kratu and in the Āśvina-śastra, for the Ṛks in the Triṣṭubh metre. It is stated in the sūtra उषो वाजेनेदमु त्यत (*uṣo vājenedamu tyata*) (Ā. 4-14).

Anuvāda: This sūkta उषो वाजेन (*uṣo vājena*) is the eighth sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has seven Ṛks. Its seer is Viśvāmitra; the deity is Uṣas; the metre is Triṣṭubh. In the Anukramaṇī it is said उष उषस्यं (*uṣa uṣasyaṃ*). At the time of reciting the Prātaranuvāka mantras, this sūkta is applied to the Triṣṭubh Ṛks of the Āśvina-śastra mantras connected with the Uṣasya kratu, as explained by the Āśvalāyana-śrauta-sūtra, in the sūtra उषो वाजेनेदमु तृत (*uṣo vājenedamu tṛta*)[?229] (Ā. 4-14).

Sūkta 61. Maṇḍala 3. Anuvāka 5. Sūkta 61. Aṣṭaka 3. Adhyāya 4. Varga 8. Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 7. Seer: Viśvāmitra. Deity: Uṣas. Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उषो॒ वाजे॑न वाजिनि॒ प्रचे॑ता॒ः स्तोमं॑ जुषस्व गृण॒
तो म॑घोनि ।
पु॒रा॒णी दे॑वि युव॒तिः पुरं॑धि॒रनु॑ व्र॒तं च॑रसि विश्ववा
रे ॥ १ ॥

> *uṣo vājena vājini pracetāḥ stomaṃ juṣasva gṛṇato maghoni |*
> *purāṇī devi yuvatiḥ puraṃdhiranu vrataṃ carasi viśvavāre ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उषः । वाजेन । वाजिनि । प्रचेताः । स्तोमं । जुषस्व । गृणतः । मघोनि ।
> पुराणी । देवि । युवतिः । पुरंठधिः । अनु । व्रतं । चरसि । विश्ववारे ॥ १ ॥

> *uṣaḥ | vājena | vājini | pracetāḥ | stomaṃ | juṣasva | gṛṇataḥ | maghoni |*
> *purāṇī | devi | yuvatiḥ | puraṃṭhadhiḥ | anu | vrataṃ | carasi | viśvavāre ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वाजेन वाजिन्यन्नेनान्नवति । तथा च मंत्रः । सं वाजैर्वाजिनीवति । ऋग्वे. १–४८–१६ । इति । मघोनि धनवति हे उषः प्रचेताः प्रकृष्टज्ञानवती सती गृणतः तव स्तोत्रं कुर्वतः स्तोतुः स्तोमं स्तोत्रं जुषस्व । सेवस्व । यद्वा । वाजेन हनिर्लक्षणेनान्नेन सह स्तोमं जुषस्विति संबंधः । विश्ववारे विश्वैः सर्वैर्वर्णनीये हे उषो देवि पुराणी पुरातनी युवतिरित्युपमा तद्वच्छोभमाना । सुसंकाशा मात्सम्यष्टेव योषा । ऋग्वे १–१२३–११ । इतिवत् । पुरंधिः । पुरु बहु धीः स्तोत्रलक्षणं कर्म यस्याः सा । बहुस्तोत्रवती । पुरंधिर्बहुधीरिति यास्कः । पुरंधिः शोभमाना ना । एवंविधगुणोपेता त्वमनु व्रतं यज्ञकर्माभिलक्ष्य चरसि। यष्टव्यतया वर्तसे ॥ मघोनि । मघशब्दान्मतुबर्थे छंदसीवनिपाविति वनिप् । स्त्रियामृन्नेभ्यो जीप् । श्वयुवमघोनामतद्धित इति संप्रसारणे कृते गुणः । संबुद्धावंबार्थनद्योर्ह्रस्वः । निघातः । पुराणी । पुराणशब्दः

> पुराणप्रोक्तेष्टित्यंतोदात्तत्वेन निपातितः । टिड्ढाणइंति जीप् । अनुदात्तस्य च
> यत्रोदात्तलोप इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं । पुरंधिः । पृषोदरादित्वादुकारस्यामादेश
> ईकारस्य ह्रस्वश्च । आद्युदात्तप्रकरणे दिवोदासादीनां छंदस्युपसंख्यानमित्याद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *vājena vājinyannenānnavati | tathā ca maṃtraḥ | saṃ vājairvājinīvati | ṛgve.*
> *1-48-16 | iti | maghoni dhanavati he uṣaḥ pracetāḥ prakṛṣṭajñānavatī satī gṛṇataḥ*
> *tava stotraṃ kurvataḥ stotuḥ stomaṃ stotraṃ juṣasva | sevasva | yadvā |*
> *vājena hanirlakṣaṇenānnena saha stomaṃ juṣasviti saṃbaṃdhaḥ | viśvavāre viśvaiḥ*
> *sarvairvarṇanīye he uṣo devi purāṇī purātanī yuvatirityupamā*
> *tadvacchobhamānā | susaṃkāśā mātsamyaṣṭeva yoṣā | ṛgve 1-123-11 | itivat | puraṃdhiḥ |*
> *puru bahu dhīḥ stotralakṣaṇaṃ karma yasyāḥ sā | bahustotravatī |*
> *puraṃdhirbahudhīriti yāskaḥ | puraṃdhiḥ śobhamānā nā |*
> *evaṃvidhaguṇopetā tvamanu vrataṃ yajñakarmābhilakṣya carasi|*
> *yaṣṭavyatayā vartase ‖ maghoni | maghaśabdānmatubarthe*
> *chaṃdasīvanipāviti vanip | striyāmṛnnebhyo jīp |*
> *śvayuvamaghonāmataddhita iti saṃprasāraṇe kṛte guṇaḥ |*
> *saṃbuddhāvaṃbārthanadyorhrasvaḥ | nighātaḥ | purāṇī | purāṇaśabdaḥ*
> *purāṇaprokteṣṭityaṃtodāttatvena nipātitaḥ | ṭiḍḍāṇaiṃti jīp | anudāttasya ca*
> *yatrodāttalopa ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | puraṃdhiḥ | pṛṣodarāditvādukārasyāmādeśa*
> *īkārasya hrasvaśca | ādyudāttaprakaraṇe divodāsādīnāṃ chaṃdasyupasaṃkhyānamityādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

वाजेन (*vājena*) means "with food"; वाजिनी (*vājinī*) means "possessing food". So the mantra सं वाजैर्वाजिनीवति (*saṃ vājairvājinīvati*) (Ṛgve. 1-48-16). मघोनि (*maghoni*): O wealthy Uṣas, being प्रचेताः (*pracetāḥ*), one of excellent knowledge, enjoy (जुषस्व (*juṣasva*), "serve") the praise of the praiser who praises you. Or else: enjoy the praise together with the food that has the oblation as its mark (havir-lakṣaṇa). विश्ववारे

(*viśvavāre*): O Uṣas, to be extolled by all; पुराणी (*purāṇī*), ancient; युवतिः (*yuvatiḥ*) is a simile: shining like a young woman, as in सुसंकाशा मात्सम्यष्टेव योषा । (*susaṃkāśā mātsamyaṣṭeva yoṣā* |) (Ṛgve. 1-123-11)[?230]. पुरंधिः (*puraṃdhiḥ*): she whose work, consisting of praise, is much (पुरु बहु धीः (*puru bahu dhīḥ*)), one with many praises; Yāska: पुरंधिर्बहुधीरिति (*puraṃdhirbahudhīriti*). Possessed of such qualities, you go about (चरसि (*carasi*)) in regard to the rite (व्रतं (*vrataṃ*)), the sacrificial action, that is, you are present as one to be worshipped. The remainder gives derivations and accent rules (not rendered here).

Word-to-word meaning

- वाजेन वाजिनि (*vājena vājini*)—endowed with abundance of food
- मघोनि (*maghoni*)—and wealthy
- उषः (*uṣaḥ*)—O Uṣas
- प्रचेताः (*pracetāḥ*)—having excellent intelligence
- गृणतः (*gṛṇataḥ*)—of him who praises you
- स्तोमं (*stomaṃ*)—the praise
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept
- विश्ववारे (*viśvavāre*)—honoured by all
- देवि (*devi*)—of divine nature
- पुराणी (*purāṇī*)—ancient
- युवतिः (*yuvatiḥ*)—ever young
- पुरंधिः (*puraṃdhiḥ*)—you who are worthy of many praises
- अनुव्रतं (*anuvrataṃ*)—showing favour to the sacrificial rite
- चरसि (*carasi*)—you act

Gist

O Uṣas, possessed of abundance of food and wealthy, you who have excellent intelligence, accept the praise of the praiser who praises you. Honoured by all, of divine nature, ancient, ever young, worthy of many praises, you go about showing favour to the sacrificial rite.

English translation

Affluent Ushas, giver of sustenance, possessed of intelligence, be propitiated by the praise of him who lauds you, (and worships) with (sacrificial) food : divine Ushas, adored by all, you (though) ancient are (still) young ; the object of manifold worship, you are present at the recurring (morning) rite.

Special Topics

All the Ṛks that praise Uṣas have the form of supreme poetry. Epithets such as पुराणी (*purāṇī*) and युवतिः (*yuvatiḥ*), which ordinarily show opposite qualities, describe those same qualities in Uṣas at one and the same time. Among all such epithets, the epithet पुरंधि (*puraṃdhi*) shows the all-pervading qualities of Uṣas.

पुरंधिर्बहुधीस्तत्कः पुरंधिर्भगः पुरस्तात्तस्यान्वादेश इत्येकं। इंद्र इत्यपरं स बहुकर्मतः पुरां च दारयितृतमः । वरुण इत्यपरं तं प्रज्ञया स्तौति ॥ (*puraṃdhirbahudhīstatkaḥ puraṃdhirbhagaḥ purastāttasyānvādeśa ityekaṃ| iṃdra ityaparaṃ sa bahukarmataḥ purāṃ ca dārayitṛtamaḥ | varuṇa ityaparaṃ taṃ prajñayā stauti ‖*) (Ni. 6-13).

This explanation the Nirukta-kāra gave when citing the Ṛk भगं नासत्या पुरंधिं (*bhagaṃ nāsatyā puraṃdhiṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-39-4). The Nirukta-kāra explains this word as "one possessed of abundant understanding (धी (*dhī*))". That is, other examples too show that the word is used when conveying the senses of abundance, fullness, prosperity and the like. In the Nirukta again the Ṛk

आदाय श्वेनो अभरत्सोमं सहस्रं सवा अयुतं च साकं । अत्रा पुरंधिरजहादरातीर्मदे सोमस्य मूरा अमूरः । (*ādāya śveno abharatsomaṃ sahasraṃ savā ayutaṃ ca sākaṃ | atrā puraṃdhirajahādarātīrmade somasya mūrā amūraḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-26 7)[?231]

is cited (Ni. 11-2). For this word Sāyaṇa says बहुकर्म (*bahukarma*), the abundance of action, and Durgācārya in the Nirukta says बहु नः धनस्य दाता (*bahu naḥ dhanasya dātā*), one who gives wealth in great abundance. Again the Nirukta-kāra … (the window ends here; the sentence continues in the next).

The Ṛk

पावीरवी तन्यतुरेकपादजो दिवो धर्ता सिंधुरापः समुद्रियः । विश्वे देवासः शृणवन् वचांसि मे सरस्वती सह धीभिः पुरंध्या ॥ (*pāvīravī tanyaturekapādajo divo dhartā siṃdhurāpaḥ samudriyaḥ | viśve devāsaḥ śṛṇavan vacāṃsi me sarasvatī saha dhībhiḥ puraṃdhyā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-65-13)

is also quoted (Ni. 12-30). Here the word *purandhi* is explained as "made use of by praise": words accompanied by manifold praises. Commenting on this same mantra, Sāyaṇa says बहुविधया प्रज्ञया सहिता सरस्वती (*bahuvidhayā prajñayā sahitā sarasvatī*), that is, "Sarasvatī endowed with manifold wisdom", and he treats it as an epithet of Sarasvatī. But from Durgācārya's explanation (Ni. 12-30), बहुधात्रा माध्यमिकया वाचा (*bahudhātrā mādhyamikayā vācā*), it is understood that Purandhi is a particular deity resembling Sarasvatī. Likewise, in

शं नो भगः शमु नः शंसो अस्तु शं नः पुरंधिः शमु संतु रायः । शं नः सत्यस्य सुयमस्य शंसः शं नो अरमा पुरुजातो अस्तु ॥ (*śaṃ no bhagaḥ śamu naḥ śaṃso astu śaṃ naḥ puraṃdhiḥ śamu saṃtu rāyaḥ | śaṃ naḥ satyasya suyamasya śaṃsaḥ śaṃ no aramā purujāto astu ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-35-2)

and similar Ṛks, just as deities such as Bhaga and Aramā are prayed to, Purandhi too is prayed to for protective and auspicious favour. Sāyaṇa also, in his bhāṣya, says that Purandhi is a separate deity.

In many places this word is used of the wife or of woman in general, and gives the sense of women who are not barren, who are fit to obtain wealth of offspring and are well-nourished. For example, in

अग्निः सप्तिं वाजंभरं ददात्यग्निर्वीरं श्रुत्यं कर्मनिष्ठां । अग्नी रोदसी वि चरत्समंजन्नग्निर्नारीं वीरकुक्षिं पुरंधिं ॥ (*agniḥ saptiṃ vājaṃbharaṃ dadātyagnirvīraṃ śrutyaṃ karmaniṣṭhāṃ | agnī rodasī vi caratsamaṃjannagnirnārīṃ vīrakukṣiṃ puraṃdhiṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-80-1)

and similar Ṛks it is understood as a wife capable of bearing children, and in

प्र बोधया पुरंधिं जार आ ससतीमिव । (*pra bodhayā puraṃdhiṃ jāra ā sasatīmiva |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-134-3)

and similar Ṛks, as a woman fit for enjoyment. Thus this epithet, which has the capacity to convey manifold qualities, in the present Ṛk conveys the many qualities of Ushas.

Sāyaṇa here explains the word *dhī* as praise, and states one purport as "having much praise" and another as "or shining much". Since it conveys abundant and plentiful quality, all the above-mentioned qualities are fully present in Ushas.

Whether one says she has abundant intelligence, or has ritual action, or has praise, or is a giver of wealth, or is capable of bringing forth because she is the giver of food to the world and the giver of vitality, any sense one states fits.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उषो॑ दे॒व्यम॑र्त्या॒ वि भा॑हि च॒न्द्रर॑था सू॒नृता॑ ई॒रय॑न्ती ।
आ त्वा॑ वहन्तु सु॒यमा॑सो॒ अश्वा॒ हिर॑ण्यवर्णां पृथु॒पाज॑सो॒ ये ॥ २ ॥

> *uṣo devyamartyā vi bhāhi candrarathā sūnṛtā īrayantī |*
> *ā tvā vahantu suyamāso aśvā hiraṇyavarṇāṃ pṛthupājaso ye ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उषः । देवि । अमर्त्या । वि । भाहि । चंद्ररथा । सूनृताः । ईरयंती ।
> आ । त्वा । वहंतु । सुयमासः । आश्वाः । हिरण्यवर्णां । पृथुपाजसः । ये ॥ २ ॥

> *uṣaḥ | devi | amartyā | vi | bhāhi | caṃdrarathā | sūnṛtāḥ | īrayaṃtī |*
> *ā | tvā | vahaṃtu | suyamāsaḥ | āśvāḥ | hiraṇyavarṇām | pṛthupājasaḥ | ye ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे उषो देव्यमर्त्या मरणधर्मरहिता चंद्ररथा सुवर्णमयरथोपेता
> सूनृताः प्रियसत्यरूपा वाच ईरयंत्युच्चारयंती । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । सुम्मावरी सूनृता ईरयंती । ऋग्वे. १–११३–१२ । इति । तादृशी त्वं वि भाहि । सूर्यकिरणसंबंधाद्विशेषेण दीप्यस्व :

> पृथुपाजसः प्रभूतबलयुक्ता अरुणवर्णा यः ५श्वा
> विद्यंते सुयमासः सुष्टु नियंतुं शक्या रथे योजितास्तेऽश्वा हिरण्यवर्णां त्वा
> श्वामा वहंतु ॥ सुयमासः । यमेरकृच्छार्थे खल् । लित्स्वरः ॥

> *he uṣo devyamartyā maraṇadharmarahitā caṃdrarathā suvarṇamayarathopetā*
> *sūnṛtāḥ priyasatyarūpā vāca īrayaṃtyuccārayaṃtī | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ | summāvarī sūnṛtā īrayaṃtī | ṛgve. 1-113-12 | iti |*
> *tādṛśī tvaṃ vi bhāhi | sūryakiraṇasaṃbaṃdhādviśeṣeṇa dīpyasva :*
> *pṛthupājasaḥ prabhūtabalayuktā aruṇavarṇā yaḥ 5śvā*
> *vidyaṃte suyamāsaḥ suṣṭu niyaṃtuṃ śakyā rathe yojitāste 'śvā hiraṇyavarṇāṃ tvā*
> *śvāmā vahaṃtu ‖ suyamāsaḥ | yamerakṛcchārthe khal | litsvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Ushas, divine, immortal (free from the nature of death), possessed of a golden chariot, uttering (*īrayantī*) the *sūnṛtā*, speech of pleasant truth. The mantra text says so: सुम्मावरी सूनृता ईरयंती (*summāvarī sūnṛtā īrayaṃtī*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-113-12). Such as you are, shine forth: blaze in a special way through connection with the sun's rays. The horses that are of great strength (*pṛthupājasaḥ*) and ruddy in colour, easy to restrain (*suyamāsaḥ*) and yoked to the chariot—may those horses bring you, golden-hued.

Word-to-word meaning

- देवि (*devi*)—divine in nature
- उषः (*uṣaḥ*)—O goddess Ushas
- अमर्त्या (*amartyā*)—free from the nature of death
- चंद्ररथा (*caṃdrarathā*)—possessing a golden chariot
- सूनृताः (*sūnṛtāḥ*)—pleasant words
- ईरयंती (*īrayaṃtī*)—uttering
- विभाहि (*vibhāhi*)—shine
- पृथुपाजसः (*pṛthupājasaḥ*)—of abundant strength
- ये अश्वाः (*ye aśvāḥ*)—whichever horses
- सुयमास (*suyamāsa*)—those that are yoked to the chariot
- हिरण्यवर्णां (*hiraṇyavarṇāṃ*)—golden in form

- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- आ वहंतु (*ā vahaṃtu*)—may they carry (hither)

Gist

O divine Ushas, shine, immortal, possessed of a golden chariot, uttering pleasant words. May the horses of abundant strength, yoked to the chariot, bear you, golden in form, hither.

English translation

Ushas, who are divine and immortal, mounted in a golden chariot, shine radiant, causing to be heard the sounds of truth; may your vigorous and well-trained horses bring you who are golden-haired, (hither),

Special Topics

Candrarathā: the word *candra* is read among the names of gold (Ni. 2-10). *Candrarathā* means one having a golden chariot. Or, following the Nirukta's explanation चंद्रश्चंदतेः कांतिकर्मणः । (*caṃdraścaṃdateḥ kāṃtikarmaṇaḥ* |) (Ni. 11-5), that the word *candra* may be formed from the root *cand*, giving the sense "radiant, delightful", Sāyaṇa, in

वि तद्ययुररुणयुग्भिरश्वैश्चित्रं भांत्युषसश्चंद्ररथाः । अग्रं यज्ञस्य बृहतो नयंतीर्वि ता बाधंते तम ऊर्माया: ॥ (*vi tadyayuraruṇayugniraśvaiścitraṃ bhāṃtyuṣasaścaṃdrarathāḥ | agraṃ yajñasya bṛhato nayaṃtīrvi tā bādhaṃte tama ūrmāyāḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-65-2)

explains *candrarathāḥ*, an epithet of the Ushases, as "having radiant chariots". Likewise, in

चंद्रमग्निं चंद्ररथं हरिव्रतं वैश्वानरमप्सुषदं स्वर्विदं । विगाहं तूर्णिं तविषीभिरावृतं भूर्णिं देवास इह सुश्रियं दधुः ॥ (*caṃdramagniṃ caṃdrarathaṃ harivrataṃ vaiśvānaramapsuṣadaṃ svarvidaṃ | vigāhaṃ tūrṇiṃ taviṣībhirāvṛtaṃ bhūrṇiṃ devāsa iha suśriyaṃ dadhuḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-3-5)

Sāyaṇa explains *candrarathaṃ*, an epithet of Vaiśvānara Agni, as आह्लादकः रथः यस्य । (*āhlādakaḥ rathaḥ yasya* |), "one whose chariot is gladdening", that is, having a chariot that causes joy. Hence in the present Ṛk too the sense may be stated either as a golden chariot or as a chariot that produces joy.

Sūnṛtāḥ īrayantī: *sūnṛtā*, *sūnṛtāvatī*, *sūnṛtāvarī* and the like are all epithets or synonyms of Ushas (Ni. 2-19): सूनृतेति वाज्नाम । (*sūnṛteti vājnāma* |) *Netrī*: producer. उषसः प्रादुर्भवानंतरं हि पशुपक्षिमृगादयः सर्वे शब्दं कुर्वंति । अतस्मैव तासां वाचां प्रवर्तयिता इत्युच्यते । (*uṣasaḥ prādurbhavānaṃtaraṃ hi paśupakṣimṛgādayaḥ sarve śabdaṃ kurvaṃti* | *atasmaiva tāsāṃ vācāṃ pravartayitā ityucyate* |) The word *sūnṛta* applies to all

manner of speech-activity. Since, after the rising of Ushas, the speech-activity of all animals, birds and the rest begins, the meaning is that Ushas herself is the producer of all of it. Kutsa and Vasiṣṭha have used this epithet abundantly. In

एषा गेत्री राधसः सूनृतानामुषा उच्छंती रिभ्यते वसिष्ठैः । (*eṣā getrī rādhasaḥ sūnṛtānāmuṣā ucchaṃtī ribhyate vasiṣṭhaiḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-76-7)

and a few similar places only, Sāyaṇa explains *sūnṛtānām* as "leader of praises". In the present Ṛk it reads *sūnṛtāḥ īrayantī*; the meaning is either "uttering pleasant words" or "impelling".

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उष॑ः प्रती॒ची भुव॑नानि॒ विश्वो॒र्ध्वा ति॑ष्ठस्य॒मृत॑स्य के॒तुः ।
स॒मा॒नमर्थं॑ चरणी॒यमा॑ना च॒क्रमि॑व नव्य॒स्या व॑वृत्स्व ॥ ३ ॥

> *uṣaḥ pratīcī bhuvanāni viśvordhvā tiṣṭhasyamṛtasya ketuḥ* |
> *samānamarthaṃ caraṇīyamānā cakramiva navyasyā vavṛtsva* ‖ 3 ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> उषः । प्रतीची । भुवनानि । विश्वा । ऊध्व्र्या । तिष्ठसि । अमृतस्य । केतुः ।
> समानं । अर्थं । चरणीयमाना । चक्रंइव । नव्यसि । आ । ववृत्स्व ॥ ३ ॥

> *uṣaḥ | pratīcī | bhuvanāni | viśvā | ūrdhvyā | tiṣṭhasi | amṛtasya | ketuḥ |*
> *samānaṃ | arthaṃ | caraṇīyamānā | cakraṃiva | navyasi | ā | vavṛtsva ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे उषो देवि विश्वा सर्वाणि भुवनानि प्रतीची । प्रत्याभिमुख्येनांचति
> प्राप्योतीति प्रतीची । अमृतस्य मरणधर्मरहितस्य सूर्यस्य केतुः प्रज्ञापयित्रि
> त्वमूर्ध्वा नभस्युन्नता तिष्ठसि । नव्यसि पुनःपुनर्जायमानतया नवतरे हे उषो
> देव्यर्थं । अर्यते गम्यतेऽस्मिन्नित्यर्थो मार्गः । समानमेकं मार्गमुदयात्पाचीनकाललक्षणं
> चरणीयमाना चरितुमिच्छंती त्वमा ववृत्स्व । पुनस्तस्मिन्मार्ग
> आवृत्ता भव । तत्र दृष्टांतः । चक्रमिव । यथा नभसि चरितुः सूरस्य रथांगं पुनःपुनरावर्तते
> तद्वत् ॥ प्रतीची । प्रतिपूर्वादंचतेः क्विन्। अंचतेश्चोपसंख्यानमिति
> जीप् । अच इत्यकारलोपे चाविति दीर्घः। उदात्तनिवृत्ति स्वरेणांतोदात्तः। केतुः।
> चाय पूजानिशामनयोरित्यस्माच्चायः की चेति तुः । की इत्यादेशः । आर्धधातु–

> *he uṣo devi viśvā sarvāṇi bhuvanāni pratīcī | pratyābhimukhyenāṃcati prāpyotīti pratīcī | amṛtasya maraṇadharmarahitasya sūryasya ketuḥ prajñāpayitri*
> *tvamūrdhvā nabhasyunnatā tiṣṭhasi | navyasi punaḥpunarjāyamānatayā navatare he uṣo*
> *devyarthaṃ | aryate gamyate 'sminnityartho mārgaḥ | samānamekaṃ mārgamudayātpācīnakālalakṣaṇaṃ caraṇīyamānā caritumicchaṃtī tvamā vavṛtsva | punastasminmārga*
> *āvṛttā bhava | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | cakramiva | yathā nabhasi carituḥ sūrasya rathāṃgaṃ punaḥpunarāvartate tadvat ‖ pratīcī | pratipūrvādaṃcateḥ kvin| aṃcateścopasaṃkhyānamiti*
> *jīp | aca ityakāralope cāviti dīrghaḥ| udāttanivṛtti svareṇāṃtodāttaḥ| ketuḥ|*
> *cāya pūjāniśāmanayorityasmāccāyaḥ kī ceti tuḥ | kī ityādeśaḥ | ārdhadhātu-*

> कलक्षणो गुणः । अर्थं । आर्तेस्थन्प्रत्ययः । नव्यसि । नवशब्दादीयसुनि जीपि
> रूपं । ईकारलोपश्छांदसः । ववृत्स्व । वृतु वर्तने । बहुलं छंधसीति विकरणस्य
> श्लुः ॥

> *kalakṣaṇo guṇaḥ | arthaṃ | ārtesthanpratyayaḥ | navyasi |*
> *navaśabdādīyasuni jīpi*
> *rūpaṃ | īkāralopaśchāṃdasaḥ | vavṛtsva | vṛtu vartane | bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdhasīti vikaraṇasya*
> *śluḥ ||*

Summary

O goddess Ushas, you are *pratīcī* to all the worlds: she who "turns towards and reaches" them. You, as the *ketu*, the making-known, of the immortal sun (free from the nature of death), stand aloft in the sky. O *navyasī*, newer, being born again and again, O Ushas: *artha* means a road, that by which one goes (*aryate*). Wishing to travel the one same road, of the time preceding sunrise, you turn back (*ā vavṛtsva*): become again returned to that road. An example: like a wheel (*cakram iva*): as the wheel of the chariot of the sun moving in the sky revolves again and again.

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The remainder of the block is purely grammatical (the formation of *artham*, *navyasi*, *vavṛtsva*); it is left to the Grammar section.

Word-to-word meaning

- उषः (*uṣaḥ*)—O goddess Ushas
- विश्वा भुवनानि (*viśvā bhuvanāni*)—all the worlds
- प्रतीची (*pratīcī*)—pervading
- अमृतस्य (*amṛtasya*)—of the deathless sun
- केतुः (*ketuḥ*)—as the one who makes known
- ऊर्ध्व (*ūrdhva*)—in the sky
- तिष्ठसि (*tiṣṭhasi*)—you stand
- नव्यसि (*navyasi*)—O Ushas, who appear new every day
- समानं अर्थं (*samānaṃ arthaṃ*)—the one same road
- चरणीयमाना (*caraṇīyamānā*)—wishing to travel
- चक्रमिव (*cakramiva*)—as a wheel turns
- आ ववृत्स्व (*ā vavṛtsva*)—you are one whose motion recurs every day

Gist

O goddess Ushas, pervading all the worlds, as the one who makes known the deathless sun, you stand in the sky. O Ushas, who appear new every day, wishing to travel the one same road, you are one whose motion recurs every day, as a wheel turns.

English translation

Ushas, who spread over all the regions, you abide on high, the ensign of the immortal (sun), purposing to travel the same road, repeatedly turn back ever new, (revolving) like a wheel.

Special Topics

The idea suggested by words such as *navyasi*, *cakram iva ā vavṛtsva* is explained in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā. There it is described that the thirty forms of Ushas revolve in a circle, that those thirty forms propound one and the same principle, and that there is an inseparable relation between the path of Ṛta and the revolving of Ushas. Although she appears anew again and again, her beginninglessness is described by sentences such as "ever and again being born, ancient". The Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa too says this:

इमा एव ता उषसो याः प्रथमा व्यौच्छन् । ता देव्यः कुर्वते पंचरूपा । शश्वतीर्नावपृज्यंति । न गमंत्यंतं ॥ (*imā eva tā uṣaso yāḥ prathamā vyaucchan | tā devyaḥ kurvate paṃcarūpā | śaśvatīrnāvaprjyaṃti | na gamaṃtyaṃtaṃ ‖*) (Tā. Brā. 2-5-6-5)

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"*Viśvā bhuvanāni pratīcī*": the form of Ushas described in the present Ṛk as having pervaded and shone over all the worlds is that same first form of Ushas, as it was at the time of creation. There is no difference in it. "Those same Ushases are present every day": the very form of that Ushas continues even now, uninterruptedly and infinitely (Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara). Though she takes five forms, beginning with spring, the basic principle is one. It is unbroken. Though it recurs like a wheel, it follows one path of Ṛta.

आदर्शि गातुरुरवे वरीयसी पंथा ऋतस्य समयंस्त रश्मिभिश्च क्षुर्भगस्य रश्मिभिः। (*ādarśi gāturūrave varīyasī paṃthā ṛtasya samayaṃsta raśmibhiśca kṣurbhagasya raśmibhiḥ|*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-136-2)

In this description, that for the sun of wide extent the still wider path of Ṛta was marked out with the help of his rays, the broad path of Ṛta in the sky that is indicated is the eternal course of Ushas.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अव॒ स्यूमे॑व चिन्व॒ती म॒घोन्यु॒षा या॑ति॒ स्वस॑रस्य॒ पत्नी॑ ।
स्व१॒॑र्जन॑न्ती सु॒भगा॑ सु॒दंसा॒ आन्ता॑द्दि॒वः प॑प्रथ॒ आ पृ॑थि॒व्याः ॥ ४ ॥

> *ava syūmeva cinvatī maghonyuṣā yāti svasarasya patnī |*
> *svarjanantī subhagā sudaṃsā āntāddivaḥ papratha ā pṛthivyāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अव । स्यूम इव । चिन्वती । मघोनी । उषाः । याति । स्वसरस्य । पत्नि ।
> स्वः । जनंती । सुभगा । सुदंसाः । आ । अंतात् । दिवः । पप्रथे । आ । पृथिव्याः ॥४॥

> *ava | syūma iva | cinvatī | maghonī | uṣāḥ | yāti | svasarasya | patni |*
> *svaḥ | janaṃtī | subhagā | sudaṃsāḥ | ā | aṃtāt | divaḥ | paprathe | ā | pṛthivyāḥ ‖4‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> येयमुषाः स्यूमेव वस्त्रमिव विस्तृतं तमोऽवचिन्वत्यवचयमपक्षयं प्रापयंती मघोनी धनवती स्वसरस्य । सुष्पृष्यति क्षिपति तम इति स्वसरः सूरो वासरो वा । तस्य पत्नि सती याति गच्छति । स्वः स्वकीयं तेजो जनंती जनयंती सुभगा सुधना सौभाग्ययुक्ता ना सुदंसाः शोभनाग्नि होत्रकर्मा सेयमुषा दिवो द्युलोकस्यांतात्पृथिव्याश्चंतादावसानात्पप्रथे । प्रथते । प्रकाशत इत्यर्थः ॥
> स्यूमेव । षुवु तंतुसंताने । अविषिविशुषिभ्यः किदिति मन्प्रत्ययः । ध्योः शूङनु–

> *yeyamuṣāḥ syūmeva vastramiva vistṛtaṃ tamo 'vacinvatyavacayamapakṣayaṃ*
> *prāpayaṃtī maghonī dhanavatī svasarasya | suṣpṛṣyati kṣipati tama iti svasaraḥ sūro*
> *vāsaro vā | tasya patni satī yāti gacchati | svaḥ svakīyaṃ tejo janaṃtī janayaṃtī*
> *subhagā sudhanā saubhāgyayuktā nā sudaṃsāḥ śobhanāgni hotrakarmā seyamuṣā*
> *divo dyulokasyāṃtātpṛthivyāścaṃtādāvasānātpaprathe | prathate | prakāśata ityarthaḥ ‖*
> *syūmeva | ṣuvu taṃtusaṃtāne | aviṣiviśuṣibhyaḥ kiditi manpratyayaḥ | dhyoḥ śūḍanu-*

> नासिके चेत्यूट् । यणादेशः । सुपां सुलुगिति सोर्लुक् । नित्ताद्युदात्तः ।
> चिन्वती । शतुरनुम इति जीप उदात्तत्वं । जनंती । जन जनन इत्यस्य ण्यंतस्य शतरि
> रूपं । छंदस्युभयथेति शप आर्धधातुकत्वेन णिलोपः ॥

> *nāsike cetyūṭ | yaṇādeśaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti sorluk | nittādyudāttaḥ |*
> *cinvatī | śaturanuma iti jīpa udāttatvaṃ | janaṃtī | jana janana ityasya ṇyaṃtasya śatari*
> *rūpaṃ | chaṃdasyubhayatheti śapa ārdhadhātukatvena ṇilopaḥ ‖*

Summary

This Ushas, like a stitched garment (*syūma*), i.e. like a spread-out cloth, bringing the extended darkness to diminution (*avacaya*, decay); she is *maghonī*, wealthy; the wife of *svasara*. He who well casts away (*suṣpṛṣyati*, *kṣipati*) darkness is *svasara*, the sun or the day. Being his wife, she goes. *Svaḥ*: her own light, generating; *subhagā*, of good wealth, endowed with good fortune; *sudaṃsāḥ*, of good agnihotra-ritual action. She, Ushas, spreads (*paprathe*), shines, from the end of heaven to the end of the earth. The remainder is grammar (*syūma*, root *syu*, and so on), the next page continues it.

Grammar only (*cinvatī*, *janantī*).

Word-to-word meaning

- मघोनी (*maghonī*)—wealthy
- स्वसरस्य (*svasarasya*)—of the sun

- पत्नि (*patni*)—the wife
- उषाः (*uṣāḥ*)—goddess Ushas
- स्यूम इव (*syūma iva*)—the darkness that spreads like a cloth
- अव चिन्तती (*ava cintatī*)—destroying
- याति (*yāti*)—she goes
- स्वः (*svaḥ*)—her own light
- जनंती (*janaṃtī*)—creating (spreading)
- सुभगा (*subhagā*)—endowed with good fortune
- सुदंसाः (*sudaṃsāḥ*)—helper of excellent ritual action
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of heaven
- आ अंतात् (*ā aṃtāt*)—from the end
- पृथिव्याः आ (*pṛthivyāḥ ā*)—to the end of the earth
- पप्रथे (*paprathe*)—shines, famous

Gist

The wealthy goddess Ushas, wife of the sun, goes about destroying the darkness spread like a cloth. Spreading her own light, endowed with good fortune and a helper of excellent ritual action, she shines renowned from the end of heaven to the end of the earth.

English translation

The opulent Ushas, the bride of the far-darting (sun), throwing off (darkness) like a garment, proceeds : diffusing her own (lustre), auspicious, promoting sacred acts, she is renowned to the ends of the heaven and of the earth.

Special Topics

Svasara: सुष्टु अस्यति क्षिपति तम इति स्वसरः सूरो वासरो वा । (*suṣṭu asyati kṣipati tama iti svasaraḥ sūro vāsaro vā* |) Because it completely scatters and destroys darkness, the word *svasara* means either the sun or the day. Further on, the word *svaḥ* is explained as light.

विश्वाः पिन्वथः स्वसरस्य धेना अनु वामेकः पविरा ववर्त । (*viśvāḥ pinvathaḥ svasarasya dhenā anu vāmekaḥ pavirā vavarta* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-62-2)

In such places the precise meaning of *svasara* is stated to be the sun.

Svaḥ: this word is read among the common names, *svaḥ*, *pṛśni*, *nāka* and so on. The Nirukta says that all these are synonyms of heaven and of the sun. The sun too, being of the nature of light, is designated by the word *svaḥ*. And,

(Special Topics, continued) The nirvacana of this word, स्वतो भासं ज्योतिषां । स्वतो भासेति वा ॥ (*svato bhāsaṃ jyotiṣāṃ | svato bhāseti vā ‖*) (Ni. 9-14), and the like, was given earlier together with the special senses of the word. In the present Ṛk the word is used to describe the radiance of Uṣas.

"Wife of Svasara" (स्वसरस्य पत्नि (*svasarasya patni*)) may mean either the wife of the Sun or the wife of the day (ahas). The relation between the Sun and Uṣas is described in one way in one place and in another way elsewhere. In passages such as योषा जारस्य चक्षसा विभाति (*yoṣā jārasya cakṣasā vibhāti*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-92-11) it is established that she is the wife of Āditya.

कदा नो देवीरमृतस्य पत्निः सूरो वर्णेन शतनन्नु पासः । (*kadā no devīramṛtasya patniḥ sūro varṇena śatanannu pāsaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-5-13)

The description that the Uṣases, wives of the Sun, who give life to the world and protect it, spread out their light, is just as in the present Ṛk. But in

एता उ त्याः प्रत्यदृश्रन् पुरस्ताज्योतिर्यच्छंतीरुषसो विभातीः । अजीजनन्तूर्यं यज्ञमग्निपपाचीनं तमो आगादबुष्टं ॥ (*etā u tyāḥ pratyadṛśran purastājyotiryacchaṃtīruṣaso vibhātīḥ | ajījanantūryaṃ yajñamagnipapācīnaṃ tamo āgādabuṣṭaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-78-3)

it is said that the shining Uṣases, who spread radiance over the world, brought the Sun into being; so in some places a relation of mother and begotten is also stated.

स्यूम इव (*syūma iva*)—the word syūma is explained as "cloth". Because cloth is woven of warp and woof, it has the synonym syūma. In the same way dense darkness, like warp and woof, is here compared with syūma. In some places the same synonym stands for radiance having this quality. For example, in

सूम्यमगभस्तिमृतयुग्भि रश्वैराश्विना वसुमंतं वहेथां ॥ (*sūmyamagabhastimṛtayugbhi raśvairāśvinā vasumaṃtaṃ vahethāṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-21-3)

and similar places, स्यूमगभस्ति (*syūmagabhasti*) is said to mean either "having pleasant rays" or "having rays [of the kind called] sūta".

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अच्छा॑ वो दे॒वीमु॒षसं॑ विभा॒तीं प्र वो॑ भरध्वं॒ नम॑सा सुवृ॒क्तिम् ।
ऊ॒र्ध्वं म॑धु॒धा दि॒वि पाजो॑ अश्रे॒त्प्र रो॑च॒ना रु॑रुचे र॒ण्वसं॑दृक् ॥ ५ ॥

> *acchā vo devīmuṣasaṃ vibhātīṃ pra vo bharadhvaṃ namasā suvṛktim |*
> *ūrdhvaṃ madhudhā divi pājo aśretpra rocanā ruruce raṇvasaṃdṛk ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अच्छ । वः । देवीं । उषसं । विभातीं । प्र । वः । भरध्वं । नमसा । सुवृक्तिं ।
> ऊर्ध्वं । मधुधा । दिवि । पाजः । अश्रेत् । प्र । रोचना । रुरुचे । रण्यसंदृक् ॥

> *accha | vaḥ | devīṃ | uṣasaṃ | vibhātīṃ | pra | vaḥ | bharadhvaṃ | namasā | suvṛktiṃ |*
> *ūrdhvaṃ | madhudhā | divi | pājaḥ | aśret | pra | rocanā | ruruce | raṇyasaṃdṛk ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे स्तोतारो वो युष्मानच्छाभिलक्ष्य विभातीं शोभमानामुषसं देवीं प्रति वो युष्माकं संबंधिना नमसा नमस्कारेण सह सुवृक्तिं शोभनां स्तुतिं प्रभरध्वं । यूयं कुरुत । मधुधा । मधुराणि स्तुतिलक्षणानि वाक्यानि दधातीति । मधु सोमः । तं धारयतीति वा । यद्वा। मधुधादित्यधात्री । यद्वा । अवग्रहाभावादव्युत्पन्नावयवमखंडमिदं पदमुषोनाम । सेयमुषा दिवि नभस्यूर्ध्वं पाज ऊर्ध्वाभिमुखं पाजस्तेजोऽश्रेत् । श्रयति । तथा रोचना रोचनशीला रण्वसंदृक् रमणीयदर्शनोषाः प्र रुरुचे । प्रकर्षेण दीप्यते । यद्वा । रोचना

> लोकान्प । रुरुचे । प्रकर्षेण स्वतेजसा दीपयति । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । व्युच्छंती
> हि रश्मिभिर्विश्वमाभासि रोचनं । ऋग्वे. १–४९–४ । इति ॥ रण्वसंदृक् ।
> रवेर्गत्यर्थस्याच्प्रत्ययः । इदित्वान्नुमागमः । संपूर्वाद्दृशेः क्विन् । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः
> ॥

> *he stotāro vo yuṣmānacchābhilakṣya vibhātīṃ śobhamānāmuṣasaṃ*
> *devīṃ*
> *prati vo yuṣmākaṃ saṃbaṃdhinā namasā namaskāreṇa saha suvṛktiṃ*
> *śobhanāṃ stutiṃ*
> *prabharadhvaṃ | yūyaṃ kuruta | madhudhā | madhurāṇi*
> *stutilakṣaṇāni vākyāni dadhātīti |*
> *madhu somaḥ | taṃ dhārayatīti vā | yadvā| madhudhādityadhātrī |*
> *yadvā | avagrahābhāvādavyutpannāvayavamakhaṃḍamidaṃ*
> *padamuṣonāma | seyamuṣā divi nabhasyūrdhvaṃ pāja*
> *ūrdhvābhimukhaṃ pājastejo 'śret | śrayati | tathā rocanā rocanaśīlā*
> *raṇvasaṃdṛk ramaṇīyadarśanoṣāḥ pra ruruce | prakarṣeṇa dīpyate |*
> *yadvā | rocanā*
> *lokānpa | ruruce | prakarṣeṇa svatejasā dīpayati | tathā ca*
> *maṃtravarṇaḥ | vyucchaṃtī*
> *hi raśmibhirviśvamābhāsi rocanaṃ | ṛgve. 1-49-4 | iti ‖ raṇvasaṃdṛk |*
> *ravergatyarthasyācpratyayaḥ | iditvānnumāgamaḥ | saṃpūrvāddṛśeḥ*
> *kvin | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa addresses the praisers: turning towards you, offer to the shining goddess Uṣas, with your homage (namas), a fine hymn of praise (suvṛkti). Madhudhā: she "holds" sweet words that have the character of praise; or madhu is Soma, and she bears it; or madhudhā is "nurse of Āditya"; or, since there is no avagraha, this is an indivisible word, a name of Uṣas, with no analysable parts. This Uṣas in the sky has taken upward-directed radiance (pājas); aśret means "resorts to". Likewise, radiant and lovely to see, Uṣas shines forth greatly. Or else rocanā means "the worlds", which she lights up with her own radiance. Sāyaṇa cites the mantra text व्युच्छंती हि रश्मिभिर्विश्वमाभासि रोचनं (*vyucchaṃtī hi raśmibhirviśvamābhāsi rocanaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-49-4).

Word-to-word meaning

- वः अच्छ (*vaḥ accha*)—turned towards you (O praisers)
- विभातीं (*vibhātīṃ*)—shining
- उषसं देवीं (*uṣasaṃ devīṃ*)—addressing the goddess Uṣas
- वः (*vaḥ*)—your
- नमसा (*namasā*)—accompanied by homage
- सुवृक्तिं (*suvṛktiṃ*)—excellent praise
- प्र भरध्वं (*pra bharadhvaṃ*)—compose and offer
- मधुधा (*madhudhā*)—Uṣas, the repository of sweetness
- दिवि (*divi*)—in the sky
- ऊर्ध्वं (*ūrdhvaṃ*)—directed upward
- पाजः (*pājaḥ*)—radiance (continued on the next page)

Gist

(Given on p. 520.)

O praisers, compose and offer your excellent praise, accompanied by homage, to the goddess Uṣas who shines turned towards you. Uṣas, the repository of sweetness, has obtained in the sky radiance directed upward. Radiant and of lovely appearance, she shines exceedingly.

English translation

Offer, with your prostrations, due praise to the divine Ushas, shining upon you: the repository of sweetness manifests her brightness aloft in the sky, and, radiant and lovely, lights the regions.

Special Topics

सुवृक्तिं (*suvṛktiṃ*)—it is explained as formed from the root वृंच् (*vṛṃc*). This nirvacana shows that the praise composed after being separated out and refined is what the word vṛkti denotes. Or सुप्रवृत्ता स्तुतिः (*supravṛttā stutiḥ*): it may also mean praise composed under a most excellent impulse of the mind.

मधुधा (*madhudhā*)—two or three kinds of nirvacana are shown for this word: मधुराणि स्तुतिलक्षणानि वाक्यानि दधातीति (*madhurāṇi stutilakṣaṇāni vākyāni dadhātīti*); मधु सोमः (*madhu somaḥ*), तं धारयतीति वा (*taṃ* *dhārayatīti vā*); यद्वा (*yadvā*) मधुधा-आदित्यधात्री (*madhudhā-ādityadhātrī*); यद्वा (*yadvā*) the word is an indivisible name उषोनाम (*uṣonāma*) with no analysable parts because there is no avagraha. Sāyaṇa explains that the epithet madhudhā is fitting for Uṣas because she bears the sweet characteristics suited to praise; or because she bears Soma (madhu meaning Soma); or, if madhu is taken to mean Āditya, because she is his nurse; or because she is denoted by an indivisible word.

रण्वसंदृक् (*raṇvasaṃdṛk*)—raṇva means "lovely" and sandṛk means "form"; the sense is "having a lovely form".

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒ताव॑री दि॒वो अ॒र्कैर॑बो॒ध्या ॒रे॒वती॒ रोद॑सी चि॒त्रम॑स्थात् ।
आ॒य॒तीम॑ग्न उ॒षसं॑ विभा॒तीं वा॒ममे॑षि॒ द्रवि॑णं॒ भिक्ष॑माणः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ṛtāvarī divo arkairabodhyā revatī rodasī citramasthāt |*
> *āyatīmagna uṣasaṃ vibhātīṃ vāmameṣi draviṇaṃ bhikṣamāṇaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋत्यवरी। दिवः । अर्कैः । अबोधि । आ । रेवती । रोदसी इति । चित्रं । अस्मात् ।
> आयतीं । अग्ने । उषसं । विभातीं । वामं । एषि । द्रविणं । भिक्षमाणः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ṛtyavarī| divaḥ | arkaiḥ | abodhi | ā | revatī | rodasī iti | citraṃ | asmāt |*
> *āyatīṃ | agne | uṣasaṃ | vibhātīṃ | vāmaṃ | eṣi | draviṇaṃ | bhikṣamāṇaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ऋतावरी सत्यवती येयमुषा दिवो द्युलोकादर्केस्तेजोभिरबोधि
> सर्वैर्ज्ञायते । ततो रेवती धनवती येयं रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्यौ चित्रं
> नानाविधरूपयुक्तं यथा भवति तथास्थात् सर्वतो व्याप्य तिष्ठति हे अग्ने आयतीं
> त्वदभिमुखमागच्छंतीं विभातीं भासमानामुषसमुषोदेवीं भिक्षमाणो हवींपि
> याचमानस्त्वं नामं वननीयं द्रविणमग्नि होत्रादिलक्षणं धनमेषि । प्राप्नोषि ॥
> अबोधि । बुध अवगमने । कर्मणि लुजि चिण् भावकर्मणोरिति चिण् । चिणो
> लुक् । रेवती । रयिशब्दान्मतुप् । छंदसीर इति वत्वं । रयेर्मतौ बहुलमिति
> संप्रसारणपरपूर्वत्वे । गुणः । उगितश्चेति जीप् । रेशब्दाच्चोपसंख्यानमिति
> मतुप उदात्तत्वं ॥

> *ṛtāvarī satyavatī yeyamuṣā divo dyulokādarkèstejobhirabodhi*
> *sarvairjñāyate | tato revatī dhanavatī yeyaṃ rodasī dyāvāpṛthivyau citraṃ*
> *nānāvidharūpayuktaṃ yathā bhavati tathāsthāt sarvato vyāpya tiṣṭhati he agne āyatīṃ*
> *tvadabhimukhamāgacchaṃtīṃ vibhātīṃ bhāsamānāmuṣasamuṣodevīṃ bhikṣamāṇo havīṃpi*
> *yācamānastvaṃ nāmaṃ vananīyaṃ draviṇamagni hotrādilakṣaṇaṃ dhanameṣi | prāpnoṣi ‖*
> *abodhi | budha avagamane | karmaṇi luji ciṇ bhāvakarmaṇoriti ciṇ | ciṇo*
> *luk | revatī | rayiśabdānmatup | chaṃdasīra iti vatvaṃ | rayermatau bahulamiti*
> *saṃprasāraṇaparapūrvatve | guṇaḥ | ugitaśveti jīp | reśabdāccopasaṃkhyānamiti*
> *matupa udāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Ṛtāvarī is "possessed of truth": this Uṣas is known (abodhi) to all from the sky, the world of heaven, by her rays (arkaiḥ, "radiances"). Then she, possessed of wealth (revatī), stands pervading the two worlds, heaven and earth, in such a way that they are variously coloured (citram). O Agni, you who ask (bhikṣamāṇaḥ) for oblations from the shining goddess Uṣas as she comes towards you, obtain (eṣi) the desirable (vāmam) wealth (draviṇam) that consists of the agnihotra and the like.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋतावरी (*ṛtāvarī*)—Uṣas, who is possessed of truth
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from the world of heaven
- आर्कैः (*ārkèḥ*)—together with her radiances
- अबोधि (*abodhi*)—is known by all
- रेवती (*revatī*)—Uṣas, possessed of wealth
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth
- चित्रं (*citraṃ*)—making them to be endowed with many kinds of forms
- आ अस्थात् (*ā asthāt*)—stands pervading
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- आयतीं (*āyatīṃ*)—coming towards you
- विभातीं (*vibhātīṃ*)—and shining
- उषसं (*uṣasaṃ*)—Uṣas
- भिक्षमाणः (*bhikṣamāṇaḥ*)—you who ask for oblations
- वामं (*vāmaṃ*)—attractive
- द्रविणं (*draviṇaṃ*)—wealth that has the form of agnihotra and the like
- एषि (*eṣi*)—you obtain

Gist

Uṣas, possessed of truth, is known to all from the world of heaven together with her radiances. Uṣas, possessed of wealth, stands pervading heaven and earth, making them endowed with many kinds of forms. O Agni, you who ask for oblations from the shining goddess Uṣas coming towards you obtain attractive wealth that has the form of agnihotra and the like.

English translation

The possessor of truth is recognized in the sky by her rays : the possessor of wealth has taken a marvellous station in earth and heaven : Agni, soliciting alms of the radiant advancing Ushas,obtain your desired treasure (of oblations).

Special Topics

ऋतावरी (*ṛtāvarī*)—सत्यवती (*satyavatī*). The word ṛta means "truth". Because Uṣas guards truth, the epithet ṛtāvarī belongs to her.

अर्कैः (*arkaiḥ*)—तेजोभिः (*tejobhiḥ*), "by radiances". All radiant deities such as Agni are denoted by the word arka. For example, अग्निर्वा अर्कः (*agnirvā arkaḥ*) (Ai. Ā. 1-4-1), "Agni is Arka", and the like, is stated. Abundant radiance is also denoted by arka.

चित्रं (*citraṃ*)—the word citra is used in many senses. In the Ṛk पशून्न चित्रा सुभगा प्रधाना (*paśūnna citrā subhagā pradhānā*) (1-92-12) too, the word citrā is an epithet of Uṣas. There two meanings are given, चायनीया (*cāyanīyā*) and पूजनीया (*pūjanīyā*). The sense "charming, attractive" is the more common in use. चित्रं महनीयं (*citraṃ mahanīyaṃ*), that is, "worthy of reverence", is also a meaning. In the present place, नानाविधरूपयुक्तं (*nānāvidharūpayuktaṃ*) means Uṣas, who has assumed many kinds of forms so as to be attractive.

वामं (*vāmaṃ*)—वननीयं (*vananīyaṃ*), "desired by all". At अस्य वामस्य पलितुः (*asya vāmasya palituḥ*) (1-164-1) two kinds of meaning are given: first वननीयस्य (*vananīyasya*), one who is desired and served by all; second वामस्य विश्वस्य उद्धरितुः (*vāmasya viśvasya uddharituḥ*), one who has extended the world in the form of the universe. In the present place too both meanings can be given. Uṣas is desired by all, so she is to be sought after; moreover she is the one who, in her own manner, causes the world to be spread out. So here both meanings fit.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तस्य॑ बु॒ध्न उ॒षसा॑मिष॒ण्यन्वृषा॑ म॒ही रोद॑सी॒ आ वि॑वेश ।
म॒ही मि॒त्रस्य॒ वरु॑णस्य मा॒या च॒न्द्रेव॑ भा॒नुं वि द॑धे पुरु॒त्रा ॥ ७ ॥

> *ṛtasya budhna uṣasāmiṣaṇyanvṛṣā mahī rodasī ā viveśa |*
> *mahī mitrasya varuṇasya māyā candreva bhānuṃ vi dadhe purutrā ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतस्य । बुद्धे । उषसां । इषण्यन् । वृषा । मही इति । रोदसी इति । आ । विवेश ।
> मही । मित्रस्य । वरुणस्य । माया । चंद्राइव । भानुं । वि । दधे । पुरुत्का ॥७॥

> *ṛtasya | buddhe | uṣasāṃ | iṣaṇyan | vṛṣā | mahī iti | rodasī iti | ā | viveśa |*
> *mahī | mitrasya | varuṇasya | māyā | caṃdrāiva | bhānuṃ | vi | dadhe | purutkā ‖7‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषा वृष्टि द्वारा प्रेरक आदित्य ऋतस्याग्नि होत्रादिकर्मकरणे सत्यभूतस्याहो बुद्धे मूल
> उषसामिषण्यन् प्रेरणं कुर्वनृही महत्यौ रोदसी द्यावाप्रथिव्याना विवेश । स्वतेजोभिः सर्वतः
> प्रविष्टवान् । यद्वा । वृषा वर्षितेषण्यन्
> सर्वतो गच्छन्नुषसां संबंधी रश्मिसमूहो रोदसी द्यावापृथिव्य विष्टवानिति
> योजनीयं । तत उषा मही महती मित्रस्य वरुणस्य मित्रावरुणयोर्माया
> प्रभारूपा सती चंद्रेव सुवर्णानीव भानुं स्वप्रभां पुरुत्रा बहुषु देशेषु वि
> दधे । विदधाति । सर्वत्र प्रसारयति ॥ मही । अल्लोपश्रांदसः । पुरुत्रा ।
> देवमनुष्येत्यादिनाधिकरणे त्राप्रत्ययः ॥

> *vṛṣā vṛṣṭi dvārā preraka āditya ṛtasyāgni hotrādikarmakaraṇe*
> *satyabhūtasyāho buddhe mūla uṣasāmiṣaṇyan preraṇaṃ kurvanṛhī*
> *mahatyau rodasī dyāvāprathivyānā viveśa | svatejobhiḥ sarvataḥ*
> *praviṣṭavān | yadvā | vṛṣā varṣiteṣaṇyan*
> *sarvato gacchannuṣasāṃ saṃbaṃdhī raśmisamūho rodasī*
> *dyāvāpṛthivya viṣṭavāniti*
> *yojanīyaṃ | tata uṣā mahī mahatī mitrasya varuṇasya*
> *mitrāvaruṇayormāyā*
> *prabhārūpā satī caṃdreva suvarṇānīva bhānuṃ svaprabhāṃ purutrā*
> *bahuṣu deśeṣu vi*
> *dadhe | vidadhāti | sarvatra prasārayati ‖ mahī | allopaśrāṃdasaḥ |*
> *purutrā | devamanuṣyetyādinādhikaraṇe trāpratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

Vṛṣā is Āditya, who impels through rain. At the root (budhne) of ṛta, the day that is true in the performance of agnihotra and other rites, urging on the dawns (uṣasām iṣaṇyan), he has entered the two great worlds, heaven and earth, pervading them everywhere with his own rays. Or else: vṛṣā is the mass of Uṣas's rays, going in all directions, which has entered heaven and earth; this is how the construction is to be made. Then Uṣas, great, being as the radiance (māyā) of Mitra and Varuṇa, like gold (candreva means "like gold"), spreads out her own light (bhānum) in many places (purutrā); vidadhe means "spreads", extends everywhere.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषा (*vṛṣā*)—Āditya, the causer of rain
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of the day that is true by nature
- बुद्धे (*buddhe*)—at the root
- उषसां (*uṣasāṃ*)—to the manifestation of the Uṣases
- इषण्यन् (*iṣaṇyan*)—urging
- मही (*mahī*)—great
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—heaven and earth
- आ विवेश (*ā viveśa*)—has pervaded with his radiance (and Uṣas also)
- मही (*mahī*)—she of great nature
- मित्रस्य (*mitrasya*)—of Mitra
- वरुणस्य (*varuṇasya*)—and of Varuṇa (of Mitra and Varuṇa)
- माया (*māyā*)—being of the form of radiance
- भानुं (*bhānuṃ*)—her own light
- चंद्रेव (*caṃdreva*)—spreading it like golden lustre
- पुरुत्रा (*purutrā*)—in many regions
- विदधे (*vidadhe*)—has spread

Gist

Āditya, the causer of rain, at the root of the day that is true by nature, urging the manifestation of the Uṣases, has pervaded. Uṣas too, of great nature and being the radiance of Mitra and Varuṇa, spreads her light like golden lustre in many regions.

English translation

The showerer (of rain, the sun), urging on the dawn, at the root of the truthful (day has) pervaded the vast heaven and earth; the mighty Ushas, the golden light, as it were, of Mitra and Varuna, diffuses her lustre in different directions.

Special Topics

ऋतस्य बुद्धे (*ṛtasya buddhe*) — अह्नः मूले (*ahnaḥ mūle*): "at the root of the day, which is of the nature of truth" is the meaning. Earlier, when the path of Ushas was described, it was explained in that context what the path of ṛta is. The budhna of such a ṛta, which is of the nature of truth, must be understood to mean its root.

In the Ṛksaṃhitā the word budhna is commonly explained as root, support and so on. In some places it is also used as a synonym of the atmosphere (antarikṣa). But even when it is used in the sense of the atmosphere, the explanation of the Nirukta authors is that the atmosphere is called budhna because it holds and keeps the waters, that is, because it is the support of the water: सहबद्धा अस्मिन्, धृता आपः (*sahabaddhā asmin, dhṛtā āpaḥ*) (Ni. 10-44).

इंद्राय गिरो अनिशितसर्गा अपः प्रेरयं सगरस्य बुध्नात् ॥ (*iṃdrāya giro aniśitasargā apaḥ prerayaṃ sagarasya budhnāt ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-89-4)

Here सगरस्य बुध्नात् (*sagarasya budhnāt*) has been explained as: that which is the support of the atmosphere itself, the deep root-region of the atmosphere. The same meaning can be taken in the present ṛk also.

माया (*māyā*) — The special meanings of this word have been given earlier in this same part. Since Ushas belongs to Mitra, Varuṇa and the others, in the present context she may be called a form of radiance that is indicative of their power.

The sixty-second sūkta.

Sūkta 62 (Maṇḍala 3)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इमा उ वामित्यष्टादशर्चं नवमं सूक्तं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । इमा
> उ द्वन्नैंद्रावरुणबार्हस्पत्यपौष्णसावित्रसौम्यमैत्रावरुणास्त्वचा अंत्यो जमदग्न्यार्षो वा चतुर्थाद्या
> गायत्र्य इति । कृत्सस्य विश्वामित्र ऋषिरंत्यस्य तृचस्य
> जमदग्निर्वा । अद्यास्ति स्रस्त्रिष्टुभः शिष्टाः पंचदश गायत्र्यः । प्रथमस्येंद्रावरुणा
> देवता द्वितीयस्य बृहस्पतिस्तृतीयस्य पूषा चतुर्थस्य सविता पंचमस्य सोमः
> षष्ठस्य मित्रावरुणा ॥ अभिप्लविकेषूक्ष्येषु शृतीयसवने स्तोमवृद्धौ सत्यां
> स्वस्वशस्त्रे होत्रका अंत्यसूक्तमवशेष्य स्तोमाभिशंसनार्थं तृचादिसंख्या ऋच
> आवपेयुः । तत्र मैत्रावरुणस्यावापार्थमाद्यस्तृचः । सूत्रितं च । इमा उ नां
> भ्रमयो मन्यमाना इति तिस्त्रः । आ. ७–९ । इति ॥

> *imā u vāmityaṣṭādaśarcaṃ navamaṃ sūktaṃ | atreyamanukramaṇikā |*
> *imā*
> *u*
> *dvannaiṃdrāvaruṇabārhaspatyapauṣṇasāvitrasaumyamaitrāvaruṇāstva*
> *cā aṃtyo jamadagnyārṣo vā caturthādyā gāyatrya iti | kṛtsasya*
> *viśvāmitra ṛṣiraṃtyasya tṛcasya*
> *jamadagnirvā | adyāsti srastriṣṭubhaḥ śiṣṭāḥ paṃcadaśa gāyatryaḥ |*
> *prathamasyeṃdrāvaruṇā*
> *devatā dvitīyasya bṛhaspatistṛtīyasya pūṣā caturthasya savitā*
> *paṃcamasya somaḥ*
> *ṣaṣṭhasya mitrāvaruṇā ‖ abhiplavikeṣūkṣyeṣu śṛtīyasavane*
> *stomavṛddhau satyāṃ*
> *svasvaśastre hotrakā aṃtyasūktamavaśeṣya stomābhiśaṃsanārthaṃ*
> *tṛcādisaṃkhyā ṛca*
> *āvapeyuḥ | tatra maitrāvaruṇasyāvāpārthamādyastṛcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *imā u nāṃ*
> *bhramayo manyamānā iti tistraḥ | ā. 7-9 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning इमा उ वां (*imā u vāṃ*) has eighteen ṛks and is the ninth sūkta. Of it the Anukramaṇikā says: इमा उ द्वन्नैंद्रावरुणबार्हस्पत्यपौष्णसावित्रसौम्यमैत्रावरुणास्त्वचा अंत्यो जमदग्न्यार्षो वा चतुर्थाद्या गायत्र्य

इति (*imā u dvannaiṃdrāvaruṇabārhaspatyapauṣṇasāvitrasaumyamaitrāvaruṇās tvacā aṃtyo jamadagnyārṣo vā caturthādyā gāyatrya iti*). For the whole sūkta Viśvāmitra is the seer; for the last tṛca the seer is Jamadagni, or else (Viśvāmitra). The first ones are triṣṭubh and the remaining fifteen are gāyatrī.[?234] The deities: of the first tṛca Indra and Varuṇa, of the second Bṛhaspati, of the third Pūṣan, of the fourth Savitṛ, of the fifth Soma, of the sixth Mitra and Varuṇa.

Use: in the abhiplava ukthya rites, at the third pressing, when the stoma is to be increased, the hotṛ-priests, each at his own śastra, leave out the last sūkta and insert tṛcas and the like, of the required number of ṛks, to announce the stomas. Of these, for the insertion of the Maitrāvaruṇa, the first tṛca is used. It is also laid down in the sūtra: इमा उ नां भ्रमयो मन्यमाना इति तिस्त्रः (*imā u nāṃ bhramayo manyamānā iti tistraḥ*) (Ā. 7-9).

Anuvāda

This sūkta इमा उ वां (*imā u vāṃ*) is the ninth sūkta in the fifth anuvāka. It has eighteen ṛks. In the Anukramaṇikā it is stated: इमा उ द्वोन्यैंद्रावरुणबार्हस्पत्यपौष्टसावित्रसौम्यमैत्रावरुणास्त्रृचा अंत्यो जमदग्नार्षो वा चतुर्थाद्या गायत्र्यः (*imā u dvonyaiṃdrāvaruṇabārhaspatyapauṣṭasāvitrasaumyamaitrāvaruṇāst rṛcā aṃtyo jamadagnārṣo vā caturthādyā gāyatryaḥ*). For this whole sūkta Viśvāmitra is the seer; for the last three ṛks Viśvāmitra or Jamadagni is the seer. The first three ṛks of this sūkta are in the triṣṭubh metre; the remaining fifteen ṛks are in the gāyatrī metre. For the first tṛca, that is, the three ṛks (ṛks 1–3), Indra and Varuṇa are the deities; for the second tṛca (ṛks 4–6) Bṛhaspati, for the third tṛca (7–9) Pūṣan, for the fourth tṛca (10–12) Savitṛ, for the fifth tṛca (13–15) Soma, for the sixth tṛca (16–18) Mitra and Varuṇa are the deities. In the third pressing connected with the ukthya of the abhiplava sacrifice, when the priests of the hotṛ group recite their respective śastra-mantras, the related tṛcas of this last sūkta are to be recited for the insertion ṛks (āvapana) that are recited for the increase of the stoma; and the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa is to recite the first three ṛks for the insertion mantras (āvāpa). This is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra इमा उ वां भ्रमयो मन्यमाना इति तिस्रः (*imā u vāṃ bhramayo manyamānā iti tisraḥ*) (Ā. 7-9).

Sūkta 62.

Maṇḍala 3; Anuvāka 5; Sūkta 62.

Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 4; Varga 9, 10, 11.

Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 18.

Ṛṣi: 1–15 Viśvāmitra; 16–18 Viśvāmitra or Jamadagni.

Devatā: 1–3 Indra and Varuṇa; 4–6 Bṛhaspati (dual); 7–9 Pūṣan; 10–12 Savitṛ; 13–15 Soma; 16–18 Mitra and Varuṇa.

Chandas: 1–3 triṣṭubh; 4–18 gāyatrī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒मा उ॑ वां भृ॒मयो॒ मन्य॑माना यु॒वाव॑ते॒ न तुज्या॑
अभूवन् ।
क्व१॒॑ त्यदि॑न्द्रावरुणा॒ यशो॑ वां॒ येन॑ स्मा॒ सिनं॒ भर॑
थ॒◌ः सखि॑भ्यः ॥ १ ॥

> *imā u vāṃ bhṛmayo manyamānā yuvāvate na tujyā abhūvan |*
> *kva tyadindrāvaruṇā yaśo vāṃ yena smā sinaṃ bharathaḥ sakhibhyaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इमाः । ऊं इति । नां । भ्रमयः । मन्यमानाः । युवावते । न । तुज्याः ।
> अभूवन् ।
> क्व । त्यत् । इंद्रावरुणा । यशः । नां । येन । स्म । सिनं । भरथः । सखिभ्यः ॥ १ ॥

> *imāḥ | ūṃ iti | nāṃ | bhramayaḥ | manyamānāḥ | yuvāvate | na | tujyāḥ |*
> *abhūvan |*
> *kva | tyat | iṃdrāvaruṇā | yaśaḥ | nāṃ | yena | sma | sinaṃ | bharathaḥ | sakhibhyaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्रावरुणौ नां युवयोः संबंधिन्यो मन्यमाना बलिभिः शत्रुभिरभिमन्यमाना आत एव भ्रमयो
> भ्रमणशीला इमाः प्रजाः । उः पूरणः । युवावते । तृतीयार्थे चतुर्थि । यौवनवता बलिना
> शत्रुणा तुज्या हिंस्या नाभूवन् ।
> न भवंतु । अपि च नां युवयोस्तत्तादृशं यशः क्व कुत्रास्ते । येन यशसा
> सखिभ्योऽस्मभ्यं सिन्नमन्नं भरथः स्म प्रदातुं संपादयथः । तत्कास्त इत्यन्वयः ।
> यद्वा । हे इंद्रावरुणौ नां युवयोः संबंधिन्य इमा अस्माभिः क्रियमाणा
> भ्रमयो युवां प्राप्तुं भ्रमणशीला मन्यमानाः । मन्यतिरर्चतिकर्मा । युवामर्चंत्यस्ताः स्तुतयो
> युवावते युवाभ्यां सदृशायान्यस्मै देवाय न तुज्याः ।
> तुजतिर्दानकर्मार्थः । प्रदेया मा भूवन् । शिष्टं समानं ॥ भ्रमयः । भ्रमु
> अनवस्थाने । भ्रमेः संप्रसारणं चेतीस्त्ययः संप्रसारणं च । व्यत्ययेनांतोदात्तत्वं । युवावते ।
> युष्मदस्मद्भ्यां छंदसि सादृश्य उपसंख्यानमिति
> वतुप् । अविभक्तावपि युवादेशश्छांदसः । तुज्याः । तुज हिंसादाननिकेतनेषु ।
> अघ्न्यादयश्चेति यत् । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं । सिनं । षिञ् बंधने ।
> इण्षि इङ्जुष्यविभ्यो नगिति नक् । व्यत्ययेनाद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *he iṃdrāvaruṇau nāṃ yuvayoḥ saṃbaṃdhinyo manyamānā balibhiḥ śatrubhirabhimanyamānā āta eva bhramayo bhramaṇaśīlā imāḥ prajāḥ | uḥ pūraṇaḥ | yuvāvate | tṛtīyārthe caturthi | yauvanavatā balinā śatruṇā tujyā hiṃsyā nābhūvan |*
> *na bhavaṃtu | api ca nāṃ yuvayostattādṛśaṃ yaśaḥ kva kutrāste | yena yaśasā*
> *sakhibhyo 'smabhyaṃ sinnamannaṃ bharathaḥ sma pradātuṃ saṃpādayathaḥ | tatkāsta ityanvayaḥ |*
> *yadvā | he iṃdrāvaruṇau nāṃ yuvayoḥ saṃbaṃdhinya imā asmābhiḥ kriyamāṇā*
> *bhramayo yuvāṃ prāptuṃ bhramaṇaśīlā manyamānāḥ | manyatirarcatikarmā | yuvāmarcaṃtyastāḥ stutayo yuvāvate yuvābhyāṃ sadṛśāyānyasmai devāya na tujyāḥ |*
> *tujatirdānakarmārthaḥ | pradeyā mā bhūvan | śiṣṭaṃ samānaṃ ‖ bhramayaḥ | bhramu*

> *anavasthāne | bhrameḥ saṃprasāraṇaṃ cetīstyayaḥ saṃprasāraṇaṃ ca | vyatyayenāṃtodāttatvaṃ | yuvāvate | yuṣmadasmadbhāṃ chaṃdasi sādṛśya upasaṃkhyānamiti*
> *vatup | avibhaktāvapi yuvādeśaścāṃdasaḥ | tujyāḥ | tuja hiṃsādānaniketaneṣu |*
> *aphnyādayaścati yat | yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ | sinaṃ | piñ baṃdhane |*
> *iṇṇè iṅjuṣyavibhyo nagiti nak | vyatyayenādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Indra and Varuṇa, these subjects (prajāḥ) of yours are मन्यमाना (*manyamānā*), that is, are opposed by mighty enemies, and for that very reason are भ्रमयो (*bhramayo*), given to wandering. The word उः (*uḥ*) is a filler. युवावते (*yuvāvate*) has the dative in the sense of the instrumental: by an enemy who is young and mighty may they not become तुज्या (*tujyā*), to be harmed. And where is that fame of yours by which you provide food (सिन्नमन्नं (*sinnamannaṃ*)) to us, your friends, so as to give it? Thus the construction.

Or else: O Indra and Varuṇa, these (praises) of yours, made by us, are भ्रमयो (*bhramayo*), wandering in order to reach you, मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*); the verb मन्यति (*manyati*) has the sense of worshipping. These praises that worship you are न तुज्याः (*na tujyāḥ*) for another god like you; तुजति (*tujati*) has the sense of giving: let them not be given. The rest is the same.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रावरुणा (*iṃdrāvaruṇā*)—O Indra and Varuṇa
- नां (*nāṃ*)—those belonging to you
- मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*)—those opposed by enemies
- भृमयः (*bhṛmayaḥ*)—(therefore) those who wander about bewildered
- इमाः (*imāḥ*)—these people
- युवावते (*yuvāvate*)—by a youthful enemy
- तुज्याः (*tujyāḥ*)—harmed
- न अभूवन् (*na abhūvan*)—let them not become

- येन (*yena*)—by which fame
- सखिभ्यः (*sakhibhyaḥ*)—to us, your friends
- सिनं (*sinaṃ*)—food
- भरथः स्म (*bharathaḥ sma*)—you procure and give (such)
- नां (*nāṃ*)—your
- त्यत् यशः (*tyat yaśaḥ*)—that same renown
- क्व (*kva*)—where?

Gist

O Indra and Varuṇa, may these people, who belong to you, who are opposed by enemies and for that very reason wander about bewildered, not be harmed by a youthful enemy. Where is that renown of yours by which you procure food for us, your friends?

English translation

Indra and Varuna, may these people who are relying upon you, and wandering about (in alarm), sustain no injury from a youthful (adversary); for where is that reputation (you enjoy) on account that you bestow suste-nance on your friends.

Special Topics

Two kinds of meaning have been given for this mantra. In the first half, according to the first construction: इमाः वां भ्रमयः तुज्याः न अभूवन् (*imāḥ vāṃ bhramayaḥ tujyāḥ na abhūvan*). There is the prayer that those who belong to you and who wander about harmed by enemies may, by your grace, from now on not be harmed by enemies. The two words मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*) and भ्रमयः (*bhramayaḥ*) are both adjectives of इमाः (*imāḥ*). मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*) means those who are confronted by enemies, and भ्रमयः (*bhramayaḥ*) means those who wander about bewildered. Although the word युवावते (*yuvāvate*) ends in the dative case, the instrumental sense must be stated for it: यौवनवता बलिना शतु णा (*yauvanavatā balinā śatu ṇā*), "by an enemy who is young and strong"; the purport is that they should not be न तुज्याः (*na tujyāḥ*), harmed. According to the second construction: युवयोः संबधिन्यः इमाः अस्माभिः क्रियमाणाः भ्रमयः युवां प्राप्तंभ्रमणशीलाः मन्यमानाः अर्चंत्यस्ताः स्तुतयो युवावते युवाभ्यां सदृशायान्यस्मैदेवाय न तुज्याः न प्रदेयाः । (*yuvayoḥ* *saṃbadhinyaḥ imāḥ asmābhiḥ kriyamāṇāḥ bhramayaḥ yuvāṃ prāptaṃbhramaṇaśīlāḥ manyamānāḥ arcaṃtyastāḥ stutayo yuvāvate yuvābhyāṃ sadṛśāyānyasmaidevāya na tujyāḥ na pradeyāḥ* |). The prayer becomes: may these rites and praises performed by us not go to any other gods like you, but to you alone. According to this, the two words इमाः (*imāḥ*) and भृमयः (*bhṛmayaḥ*) are adjectives of मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*); the meaning is the praises and other rites that eagerly strive to reach you. तुज्याः (*tujyāḥ*) has the sense of giving. न तुज्याः न प्रदेयाः (*na tujyāḥ na pradeyāḥ*) is the purport.

भ्रमयः (*bhramayaḥ*) — भ्रमणशीलाः (*bhramaṇaśīlāḥ*). Generally this word is an adjective of a thing that has the action of moving about, or is a synonym for a thing showing such action. For example:

धारावरा मरुतो धृष्णोऽजसो मृगा न भीमास्तविषीभिरर्चिनः । अग्नयो न शुशुचाना ऋजीषिणो भृमिं धमंतो अप गा अवृण्वत ॥ (*dhārāvarā maruto dhṛṣṇo 'jaso mṛgā na bhīmāstaviṣībhirarcinaḥ | agnayo na śuśucānā ṛjīṣiṇo bhṛmiṃ dhamaṃto apa gā avṛṇvata* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-34-1)

There भ्राम्यंतं मेघं (*bhrāmyaṃtaṃ meghaṃ*) has been given as the meaning: the moving cloud. The Maruts, who make trees and the like all move, who are terrible and brilliant, made the wandering clouds move with still greater speed for the sake of water; here the speed of the motion too is indicated. In explaining the purport of this word in the same context, the scholar Max Müller has given his opinion in this way:

भृमि (*bhṛmi*) Seems to me a name of the cloud, driven about by the wind. The Taithiriyas read भृमिं (*bhṛmiṃ*) and Sayana explains it by मेघं धमंतश्चालयंतः (*meghaṃ dhamaṃtaścālayaṃtaḥ*). In most passages, no doubt, भृमि (*bhṛmi*) means quick, fresh and is opposed to रध्र (*radhra*), (4-32-2 ; 7-56-20) In I. 31-17, as applied to अग्नि (*agni*) it may mean quick. But in our passage, that meaning is impossible, and I prefer the tradional meaning of the cloud. Sayana's explanation according to which भृमि (*bhṛmi*) is a musical instrument, may rest on some traditional authority. [Sacred Books of the East. Vol. 32. P. 288]

In this mantra (2-31 4)[?235] भ्रमि (*bhrami*) must be understood to mean a cloud, and moreover a cloud scattered by the Maruts. Sāyaṇa too has indicated this same opinion. In many contexts it also indicates speed of motion, or the sense "new" may also be proper. For example,

इमे रद्रं चिन्मरुतो जनंति चिद्यथा वसवो जुषंत ॥ (*ime radraṃ cinmaruto janaṃti cidyathā vasavo juṣaṃta ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-56-20)

Here the word भृमि (*bhṛmi*) indicates a meaning opposed to the meaning of the word रध्र (*radhra*). रध्र (*radhra*) means a prosperous man, and भृमि (*bhṛmi*) a man in the opposite condition. That is, the रध्र (*radhra*) is well settled; the poor man must wander about. Since constant wandering is an assured activity, the poor man with such a quality is indeed denoted by the word भृमि (*bhṛmi*). In some places Sāyaṇa

has explained this word as a special musical instrument, an aid to song; it is also a synonym for horses and the like that have swift motion. In this and similar ways the scholar Max-Müller has given his opinion. Even when two meanings are taken for the word भृमि (*bhṛmi*) in the present ṛk, a devout man or a praise (stuti)[?236], motion shows itself to be the chief quality. If it is taken as a man, he is one driven away by the enemy and wandering about bewildered; if it is taken as praise, it is something wandering eagerly in order to go swiftly and reach the deity.

मन्यमानाः (*manyamānāḥ*) — The Nirukta authors have read the word मन्यते (*manyate*) both among the names of the sense of radiance (Ni. 2-6) and among the names of the sense of worshipping (Ni. 3-14). In the present context, if it is taken as praise, it means either a radiant praise or a praise worthy of worship. According to the first construction, अभिमन्यमानाः (*abhimanyamānāḥ*) means those who are struck and driven away by enemies.

सिनं (*sinaṃ*) — The word sina is read among the names of food (Ni. 2-7). As is said in places such as सुमंगलं सिनवदस्तु सातं (*sumaṃgalaṃ sinavadastu sātaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-102-11), here too the meaning is food. In some contexts it can also mean reward. But in the four or five contexts in the Ṛksaṃhitā, this word is used in the sense of food.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यमुं॑ वां पुरु॒तमो॑ रयी॒यञ्छं॑श्वत्त॒ममवं॑से जोहवीति ।
स॒जोषां॑विन्द्रावरुणा म॒रुद्भिं॑र्दि॒वा पृं॑थि॒व्या शृं॑णुत॒ं हवं॑
मे ॥ २ ॥

> *ayamu vāṃ purutamo rayīyañchaśvattamamavase johavīti |*
> *sajoṣāvindrāvaruṇā marudbhirdivā pṛthivyā śṛṇutaṃ havaṃ me ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । ऊं इति । नां । पुरुतमः । रयियन् । शश्वत्तमं । अवसे । जोहवीति ।
> सजोषौ । इंद्रावरुणा । मरुत्भिः । दिवा । पृथिव्या । शृणुतं । हवं । मे ॥ २ ॥

> *ayaṃ | ūṃ iti | nāṃ | purutamaḥ | rayiyan | śaśvattamaṃ | avase | johavīti |*
> *sajoṣau | iṃdrāvaruṇā | marutbhiḥ | divā | pṛthivyā | śṛṇutaṃ | havaṃ | me ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्रावरुणौ रयीयन् रयिमात्मन इच्छन्नयमु पुरुतमो वैदिककर्मप्रवृत्ततयातिशयेन पुरुर्महान्यजमानोऽवसे रक्षणायान्नाय वा वां युवां

> *he iṃdrāvaruṇau rayīyan rayimātmana icchannayamu purutamo vaidikakarmapravṛttatayātiśayena pururmahānyajamāno 'vase rakṣaṇāyānnāya vā vāṃ yuvāṃ*

> शश्वत्तमं सर्वदा जोहवीति । भृशमाह्वयति । मरुद्भिर्देवविशेषैर्दिना पृथिव्या च सजोषौ संगच्छंतौ युवां मे मम हवं युष्मदीयमाह्वानं शृणुतं ॥
> पुरुतमः । तमपो व्यत्ययेनाद्युदात्तत्वं । जोहवीति । ह्वयतेर्यज्लुक्यभ्यस्तस्य चेति संप्रसारणे रूपं । दिवा । ऊडिदमिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । पृथिव्या ।
> उदात्तयणो हल्पूर्वादित्युदात्तत्वं । हवं । ह्वयतेर्भाविनुपसर्गस्येत्यप् ।
> प्रत्ययस्य पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *śaśvattamaṃ sarvadā johavīti | bhṛśamāhvayati |*
> *maruddhirdevaviśeṣairdinā pṛthivyā ca*
> *sajoṣau saṃgacchaṃtau yuvāṃ me mama havaṃ yuṣmadīyamāhvānaṃ śṛṇutaṃ ‖*
> *purutamaḥ | tamapo vyatyayenādyudāttatvaṃ | johavīti |*
> *hvayateryajlukyabhyastasya ceti saṃprasāraṇe rūpaṃ | divā | ūḍidamiti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | pṛthivyā |*
> *udāttayaṇo halpūrvādityudāttatvaṃ | havaṃ |*
> *hvayaterbhāvenupasargasyetyap |*
> *pratyayasya pittvādanudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Indra and Varuṇa, this sacrificer, रयीयन् (*rayīyan*), desiring wealth for himself, is पुरुतमः (*purutamaḥ*), exceedingly great (puru) through being engaged in Vedic rites, for protection or for food, (the text breaks off here, in the middle of the sentence).

Sāyaṇa completes his explanation of the verse. The worshipper जोहवीति (*johavīti*) calls you "constantly" (शश्वत्तमं (*śaśvattamaṃ*): at all times), that is, he summons you vehemently. Associated (सजोषौ (*sajoṣau*)) with the Maruts, who are a special class of gods, and with heaven and earth, you two, Indra and Varuṇa, are to hear my invocation addressed to you.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रावरुणा (*iṃdrāvaruṇā*)—O Indra and Varuṇa
- रयियेन् (*rayiyèn*)—desiring wealth
- अयमु पुरुतमः (*ayamu purutamaḥ*)—this sacrificer, eminent through the performance of rites
- अवसे (*avase*)—for protection
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you two
- शश्वत्तमं (*śaśvattamaṃ*)—always
- जोहवीति (*johavīti*)—calls
- मरुद्भिः (*marudbhiḥ*)—with the Maruts
- दिवा (*divā*)—with the presiding deity of the heavenly world
- श्रृथिव्या च (*śṛthivyā ca*)—and with the earth

- सजोषा (*sajoṣā*)—you who are united
- मे (*me*)—my
- हवं (*havaṃ*)—invocation in the form of praise
- श्रृणुतं (*śṛṇutaṃ*)—hear

Gist

O Indra and Varuṇa, this sacrificer, eminent through the performance of rites, calls you always, desiring wealth and seeking protection. You who are united with the Maruts, with the presiding deity of the heavenly world and with the earth, hear my invocation in the form of praise.

English translation

Most diligent (in pious rites) this your worshipper), Indra and Varuna, desirous of wealth, incessantly invokes you for protection: associated with the Maruts, with heaven and earth, hear my invocation.

Special Topics

रयीयन् (*rayīyan*)—रयिं आत्मन इच्छन् (*rayiṃ ātmana icchan*): desiring wealth for himself. This states the sacrificer's wish.

पुरुतमः (*purutamaḥ*)—वैदिककर्मप्रवृत्ततेया अतिशयेन पुरुः महान् (*vaidikakarmapravṛttatèyā atiśayena puruḥ mahān*): exceedingly great (पुरुः (*puruḥ*)) through being engaged in Vedic rites. Because the sacrificer acquires greatness by performing the sacrifices and other rites prescribed by rule, the epithet पुरुतमः (*purutamaḥ*) is used. The meaning is either "one possessed of the utmost greatness" or "one possessed of abundant ritual action".

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्मे तदि॑न्द्रावरुणा॒ वसु॑ ष्याद॒स्मे र॒यिर्म॑रुत॒ः सर्व॑वीरः ।
अ॒स्मान्वरू॑त्रीः श॒रणै॑रवन्त्व॒स्मान्होत्रा॒ भार॑ती॒ दक्षि॑णाभिः ॥ ३ ॥

> *asme tadindrāvaruṇā vasu ṣyādasme rayirmarutaḥ sarvavīraḥ |*
> *asmānvarūtrīḥ śaraṇairavantvasmānhotrā bhāratī dakṣiṇābhiḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्मे इति । तत् । इंद्रावरुणा । वसु । स्यात् । अस्मे इति । रयिः । मरुतः । सर्वऽवीरः ।
> अस्मान् । वरूत्रीः । शरणैः । अवंतु । अस्मान् । होत्रा । भारती । दक्षिणाभिः ॥ ३ ॥

> *asme iti | tat | iṃdrāvaruṇā | vasu | syāt | asme iti | rayiḥ | marutaḥ | sarva 'vīraḥ |*
> *asmān | varūtrīḥ | śaraṇaiḥ | avaṃtu | asmān | hotrā | bhāratī | dakṣiṇābhiḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्रावरुणावस्मे आस्मासु तदभिलषितं तादृशं वसु धनं स्यात् । भवतु ।
> हे मरुतः सर्ववीरः सर्वेषु कर्मसु वीरः समर्थो रयिः पुत्रपौत्रयुक्तः पशुसंघः । पशवो वै रयिरिति तैत्तिरीयकं । सोऽस्मे अस्माकं भवतु । वरूत्रिः सर्वैः
> संभजनीया देवपत्न्यः शरणैः । शृणंति शीतादिक्लेशमिति शरणानि गृहाः । तैरस्मानवंतु ।
> होत्रा । हूयंतेऽस्यां हवींशीति । यद्वा । हूयते तत्र प्राण इति
> होत्रा वाक् । तथा च श्रुतिः । वाचि हि प्राणं जुहुमः प्राणे वा वाचं । कौ. उ. २–५ । इति । यद्वा । होत्रेति यज्ञनाम । हूयते तत्र हविरिति । यज्ञश्च वागुच्यते।
> वाचं यच्छंति वाग्वै यज्ञः । ऐ– ब्रा. ५–२४ । इति ब्राह्मणं । तादृशी भारती सरस्वती दक्षिणाभिर्गोरूपाभिर्दक्षिणाभिः । यद्वा । उदाराभिर्वाग्भिरस्मान् पालयतु ॥ वसु ष्यादित्यत्र संहितायां पूर्वपदादिति षत्वं । वरूत्रिः । ग्रसितस्कभितेत्यादिना जीबंतत्वेन निपातनादिष्टसिद्धिः । होत्रा । हु दानादनयोः । हुयामाश्रुभसिभ्यस्त्रन्नित्यधिकरणे त्रन्प्रत्ययः ॥

> *he iṃdrāvaruṇāvasme āsmāsu tadabhilaṣitaṃ tādṛśaṃ vasu dhanaṃ syāt | bhavatu |*
> *he marutaḥ sarvavīraḥ sarvèṣu karmasu vīraḥ samartho rayiḥ putrapautrayuktaḥ paśusaṃghaḥ | paśavo vai rayiriti taittirīyakaṃ | so 'sme asmākaṃ bhavatu | varūtriḥ sarvaiḥ*
> *saṃbhajanīyā devapalyaḥ śaraṇaiḥ | śṛṇaṃti śītādikṣeśamiti śaraṇāni gṛhāḥ | tairasmānavaṃtu | hotrā | hūyaṃte 'syāṃ havīṃśīti | yadvā | hūyate tatra prāṇa iti*
> *hotrā vāk | tathā ca śrutiḥ | vāci hi prāṇaṃ juhumaḥ prāṇe vā vācaṃ | kau. u.*
> *2-5 | iti | yadvā | hotreti yajñanāma | hūyate tatra haviriti | yajñaśca vāgucyate|*
> *vācaṃ yacchaṃti vāgvai yajñaḥ | ai- brā. 5-24 | iti brāhmaṇaṃ | tādṛśī bhāratī sarasvatī*
> *dakṣiṇābhigòrūpābhirdakṣiṇābhiḥ | yadvā | udārābhirvāgnirasmān pālayatu ‖ vasu*
> *ṣyādityatra saṃhitāyāṃ pūrvapadāditi ṣatvaṃ | varūtriḥ | grasitaskabhitetyādinā jībaṃtatvena nipātanādiṣṭasiddhiḥ | hotrā | hu dānādanayoḥ | huyāmāśrubhasibhyastrannityadhikaraṇe tranpratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra and Varuṇa, let that desired wealth be ours. O Maruts, let the wealth called सर्ववीरः (*sarvavīraḥ*) be ours: सर्ववीरः (*sarvavīraḥ*) means capable (वीरः (*vīraḥ*)) in all rites. This रयिः (*rayiḥ*) is a herd of cattle together with sons and grandsons; "cattle indeed are wealth" says the Taittirīya text. Let the वरूत्रीः (*varūtrīḥ*), the wives of the gods who are to be resorted to by all, protect us with शरणैः (*śaraṇaiḥ*), that is, with houses; houses are शरणानि (*śaraṇāni*) because they break (शृणंति (*śṛṇaṃti*)) cold and similar afflictions. As to होत्रा (*hotrā*): it is that in which oblations are offered; or else speech is होत्रा (*hotrā*) because the vital breath (प्राण (*prāṇa*)) is offered in it. Accordingly the śruti: वाचि हि प्राणं जुहुमः प्राणे वा वाचं (*vāci hi prāṇaṃ juhumaḥ prāṇe vā vācaṃ*) (Kau. U. 2-5[?237]). Or else होत्रा (*hotrā*) is a name of the sacrifice, because the oblation is offered in it; and the sacrifice is also called speech, as the Brāhmaṇa says: वाचं यच्छंति वाग्वै यज्ञः (*vācaṃ yacchaṃti vāgvai yajñaḥ*)

(Ai. Brā. 5-24). Such a Bhāratī, Sarasvatī, is to protect us with दक्षिणाभिः (*dakṣiṇābhiḥ*), that is, with gifts in the form of cows; or else, with generous speeches.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रावरुणा (*iṃdrāvaruṇā*)—O Indra and Varuṇa
- अस्मे (*asme*)—to us
- तत् (*tat*)—that which we desired
- वसु (*vasu*)—wealth
- स्यात् (*syāt*)—may it come
- मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—O Maruts
- सर्ववीरः (*sarvavīraḥ*)—all-capable
- रयिः (*rayiḥ*)—wealth accompanied by sons and grandsons
- अस्मे (*asme*)—may it come to us
- वरूत्रिः (*varūtriḥ*)—the venerable wives of the gods
- शरणैः (*śaraṇaiḥ*)—with houses fit for dwelling
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us
- अवंतु (*avaṃtu*)—let them protect
- होत्रा (*hotrā*)—the goddess of speech
- भारती (*bhāratī*)—Sarasvatī (or Sarasvatī in the form of speech)
- दक्षिणाभिः (*dakṣiṇābhiḥ*)—with wealth of cattle or wealth of speech
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us (let them protect)

Gist

O Indra and Varuṇa, may the wealth we desired come to us. O Maruts, may all-capable wealth, accompanied by sons and grandsons, come to us. May the venerable wives of the gods protect us with houses fit for dwelling; may the goddess of speech and Sarasvatī protect us with wealth of cattle or wealth of speech.

English translation

May there be to us, Indra and Varuna, such wealth (as we covet): may there be, Maruts, to us wealth (of cattle) and numerous descendants: may the delightful (wives of the gods) shelter us with dwellings : may Hotra, and Bharati (enrich) us with gifts.

Special Topics

वरूत्रीः (*varūtrīḥ*)—सर्वैः संभजनीया देवपत्न्यः (*sarvaiḥ saṃbhajanīyā devapatnyaḥ*): the wives of the gods, such as Bhāratī, venerable to all; thus their venerability is also stated. The word is used more often simply in the sense "protectors". In places such as

वरूत्रीभिः सुशरणो नो अस्तु त्वष्टा सुदत्रो वि दधातु रायः (*varūtrībhiḥ suśaraṇo no astu tvaṣṭā sudatro vi dadhātu rāyaḥ*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-34-22), वरूत्रीभिः (*varūtrībhiḥ*) is explained as उपद्रवाणां वारयित्रीभिः देवपत्नीभिः (*upadravāṇāṃ vārayitrībhiḥ devapatnībhiḥ*), that is, by the wives of the gods who ward off troubles. But in

अहिर्बुध्न्य उत नः शृणोतु वरूत्र्येकधेनुभिर्नि पातु (*ahirbudhnya uta naḥ śṛṇotu varūtryekadhenubhirni pātu*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 6 38-5) it is stated that the word वरुत्री (*varutrī*) is a synonym of the goddess of speech; one may also say "the protecting goddess of speech". In the present verse the plural वरूत्रीः (*varūtrīḥ*) is used, so one may say in general "the wives of the gods".

Whether these words होत्रा भारती (*hotrā bhāratī*) denote separate special deities, or whether they should be understood as "Bhāratī, qualified by the epithet Hotrā", is itself doubtful to the commentator.

होत्रा (*hotrā*)—Three kinds of meaning can be given to this word. First, हूयंते अस्यां हवींषि इति (*hūyaṃte asyāṃ havīṃṣi iti*): because oblations are offered in her, she may be a special deity called Hotrā

(or a Bhāratī of such a nature). In places such as होत्राः संयाजयंति (*hotrāḥ saṃyājayaṃti*) (Śa. Brā. 4-2-1-32) the word होत्राः (*hotrāḥ*) is explained as "wives of the gods"; and in contexts such as दिशः सप्त होत्राः (*diśaḥ sapta hotrāḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 7-4-1 20) it is stated to mean the deities of the directions. This will be explained further on. In the present verse the meaning as a deity is given first, and then, secondly, हूयते तत्र प्राण इति होत्रा वाक् (*hūyate tatra prāṇa iti hotrā vāk*): because the oblation is offered in speech, speech itself is what the word होत्रा (*hotrā*) denotes. He says that this meaning is stated on the authority of the śruti sentence वाचि हि प्राणं जुहुमः प्राणे वा वाचं (*vāci hi prāṇaṃ juhumaḥ prāṇe vā vācaṃ*); but he does not say which source this is. Thirdly, होत्रेति यज्ञनाम

हूयते अत्र हविरिति (*hotrèti yajñanāma hūyate atra haviriti*): because the oblation is offered in the sacrifice, the sacrifice too is denoted by the word होत्रा (*hotrā*). Or else the sacrifice is itself well known as speech. Thus:

वाचं यच्छंति । वाग्वै यज्ञः । (*vācaṃ yacchaṃti | vāgvai yajñaḥ |*)

(I. Ā. 5-24[?238]).

To restrain speech is to restrain the sacrifice itself; for speech and sacrifice are identical, both are of undivided nature: thus the non-difference of speech and sacrifice is stated. Besides this, in several other places a conjugal relation between speech and sacrifice is shown, and the unity of the two is indicated. The relation that exists between mind and speech exists also between sacrifice and speech. Indicating this same relation, how होत्रा (*hotrā*) in the present verse may be explained as the sacrifice whose nature is speech: first one must know how this unity came about. This relation is described in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa. The story tells first of the difference between sacrifice and speech and afterwards of the unity of the two, in this way.

ते देवा यज्ञमब्रुवन् । योषा ना इयं वागुपमंत्रयस्व ह्वयिष्यते वै त्वेति स्वयं ना हैवैक्षत योषा ना इयं वागुपमंत्रय्यै ह्वयिष्यते वै मेति तामुपामंत्रयत .... ॥ (*te devā yajñamabruvan | yoṣā nā iyaṃ vāgupamaṃtrayasva hvayiṣyate vai tveti svayaṃ nā haivaikṣata yoṣā nā iyaṃ vāgupamaṃtrayyai hvayiṣyate vai meti tāmupāmaṃtrayata .... ‖*)

(Tai. Brā. 3-2-1-9[?239]).

The gods said to the sacrifice: "Speech is a woman; make a sign to her to come near you." Or else the sacrifice thought in its own mind: "Speech is a woman. If I make a sign to that speech to come near me, then that woman too will make the same sign to me." But at the very first, speech refused the sacrifice's sign. That is characteristic of a woman.

ते होचुः । उपैव भगवो मंत्रयस्व ह्वयिष्यते वै त्वेति तामुपामंत्रयत सा हैनं जुहुवे तस्मादु स्त्री पुमांसग्ं ह्वयत एवोत्तमग्ं स होवाचाह्वत नै मेति ॥ (*te hocuḥ | upaiva bhagavo maṃtrayasva hvayiṣyate vai tveti tāmupāmaṃtrayata sā hainaṃ juhuve tasmādu strī pumāṃsag hvayata evottamagṃ sa hovācāhvata nai meti ‖*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-2-1-21).

Then the gods said: "Make a sign to her again in the form of an invitation. She will certainly not reject it but will give a reply." Then in the same way the sacrifice-person made a sign in the form of an invitation. She too made the same sign and called him. Then he thought: "She too has called me."

ते देवा ईक्षांचक्रिरे । योषा ना इयं वाग्यदेनं न युवितेहैव मा तिष्ठंतमभ्येहीति ब्रूहि तां तु न आगतां प्रतिप्रब्रूतादिति सा हैनं तदेव तिष्ठंतमभ्येयाय तस्मादु स्त्री पुमांसगं् संस्कृते तिष्ठंतमभ्यैति तागं्हैभ्य आगतां प्रतिप्रोवाचेयं वागादिति ॥ (*te devā īkṣāṃcakrire | yoṣā nā iyaṃ vāgyadenaṃ na yuvitehaiva mā tiṣṭhaṃtamabhyehīti brūhi tāṃ tu na āgatāṃ pratiprabrūtāditi sā hainaṃ tadeva tiṣṭhaṃtamabhyeyāya tasmādu strī pumāṃsagṃ saṃskṛte tiṣṭhaṃtamabhyaiti tāgṃhaibhya āgatāṃ pratiprovāceyaṃ vāgāditi ‖*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-2-1-22).

"This speech is a woman. This woman, belonging to the company of the Asuras, might draw the sacrifice-person to herself and win him over; then the sacrifice-person might join the Asuras." So thinking, they said to the sacrifice-person: "Do not go to her; make her come to you." In that way he made her come, and afterwards told the gods of her arrival.

तान् देवाः । असुरेभ्योंतरायंस्ताग् स्वीकृत्याग्नावेव परिगृह्य सर्वहुतमजुहवुराहुतिर्हि देवानागं् स यामेवामूमनुष्टुभाजुहवुस्तदेवैनां तद्देवाः स्वकुर्वत तेऽसुरा आत्तवचसो हेलवो हेलव इति वदंतः पराबभूवुः ॥ (*tān devāḥ | asurebhyoṃtarāyaṃstāg svīkṛtyāgnāveva parigṛhya sarvahutamajuhavurāhutirhi devānāgṃ sa yāmevāmūmanuṣṭubhājuhavustadevaināṃ taddevāḥ svakurvata te 'surā āttavacaso helavo helava iti vadaṃtaḥ parābabhūvuḥ ‖*)

(Tā. Prā. 3-2-1-23[?240]).

As soon as the woman in the form of speech, having left the Asuras, approached the sacrifice-person, the gods separated her completely from them and cut the relation she had with them. They made her wholly enveloped by fire and offered her to the gods as a full oblation. And because she was offered preceded by the anuṣṭubh metre, speech too, having become of the nature of the sacrifice, joined their side. The Asuras fled crying out.

सोऽयं यज्ञो वाचमभिदधौ । मिथुन्येनया स्यामिति तागं् संबभूव । (*so 'yaṃ yajño vācamabhidadhau | mithunyenayā syāmiti tāgṃ saṃbabhūva |*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-2-1-25)

In this way the sacrifice-person, enamoured of the woman in the form of speech and wishing to be united with her, took her wholly into himself.

इंद्रो ह वा ईक्षांचक्रे । महद्वा इतोऽभ्वं जनिष्यते यज्ञस्य च मिथुनाद्वाचश्च यन्मा तन्नाभिभवेदिति स इंद्र एव गर्भो भूत्वैतन्निथुनं प्रविवेश ॥ (*iṃdro ha vā īkṣāṃcakre | mahadvā ito 'bhvaṃ janiṣyate yajñasya ca mithunādvācaśca yanmā tannābhibhavediti sa iṃdra eva garbho bhūtvaitannithunaṃ praviveśa ‖*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-2-1-26).

After that union Indra thought: "If this conjugal relation of sacrifice and speech is left as it is, a great demonic form may arise from this pair. Without giving it room, I myself must enter into their womb." So he himself entered as the embryo of the pair.

Thus, because speech was offered in the sacrifice in the form of a full oblation, and because complete unity resulted from this offering, Sāyaṇa holds that in the present verse the name होत्रा (*hotrā*) is applied to speech in the form of the sacrifice. He has shown the sentence quoted above from the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa as the basis. And saying "such a Bhāratī, of the form of speech", he has also stated that the word होत्रा (*hotrā*) is an epithet of Bhāratī.

भरतः आदित्यः तस्य।भाः (*bharataḥ ādityaḥ tasya|bhāḥ*) (Ni. 8-13): the Āditya has the synonym Bharata, and the author of the Nirukta gives the explanation that his light is well known by the name Bhāratī.

अमू स्थिताधिलोकं तु भारती भवति ह्यसौ । सैषा तु त्रिविधा वाग्वै दिवि च व्योम्मि चेह च ॥ (*amū sthitādhilokaṃ tu bhāratī bhavati hyasau | saiṣā tu trividhā vāgvai divi ca vyommi ceha ca ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 3-13).

Among the deities in the form of speech who stand in the three worlds, the deity on the earth is called Bhāratī. Bhāratī, standing in the heavenly world, took refuge in the Āditya; that is what the author of the Nirukta calls आदित्यस्य भाः (*ādityasya bhāḥ*). But in

देव्यस्ति स्रः श्रिताश्चैनं त्वष्टा चैवैतदाश्रयः । (*devyasti sraḥ śritāścainaṃ tvaṣṭā caivaitadāśrayaḥ |*)

(Bṛ. De. 1-108)

it is stated that these three deities, shining as radiance in the three worlds, all serve the terrestrial fire, so that everything is finally declared to be connected with Agni. In saying so, support can be shown also in the Ṛk Saṃhitā:

तस्मा अग्निर्भारतः शर्म यंसज्ज्योक्षश्यात्सूर्यमुच्चरंतं । य इंद्राय सुनवामेत्याह नरे नर्याय नृतमाय नृणां ॥ (*tasmā agnirbhārataḥ śarma yaṃsajyokṣaśyātsūryamuccaraṃtaṃ | ya iṃdrāya sunavāmetyāha nare naryāya nṛtamāya nṛṇāṃ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-25-4)

Agni, the lord of oblations, is Bhārata: Agni himself is called by the word Bhārata. Because she served such an Agni, that deity is called Bhāratī. But what is the nature of this deity? As Sāyaṇa has stated in his commentary on the present verse (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-62-3), it is explained precisely that for Hotrā, prāṇa, speech and sacrifice alike a meaning referring to Bhāratī can be given on the basis of Saṃhitā and Brāhmaṇa passages. प्राणो भूत्वा प्रजा धारयन् भारतः (*prāṇo bhūtvā prajā dhārayan bhārataḥ*): Agni, having become prāṇa and sustaining creatures, was called Bhārata; Sāyaṇa cites this sentence of the Vājasaneyi Saṃhitā (Ṛ. Saṃ. Bhā. 4-25-4).

शरणैः (*śaraṇaiḥ*)—शृणंति शीतादिक्लेशमिति शरणानि गृहाः (*śṛṇaṃti śītādikleśamiti śaraṇāni gṛhāḥ*): houses are called शरण (*śaraṇa*) because they ward off cold and similar afflictions and are protective. Durgācārya, following the view of the author of the Nirukta, explained this word as "strength". Since there is a place that is spacious for dwelling and gives shelter, the meaning "strength" or "house" may be given according to context. In

उदुष्य शरणे दिवो ज्योतिरयंस्त सूर्यः । अग्निर्न शुक्रः समिधान आहुतः ॥ (*uduṣya śaraṇe divo jyotirayaṃsta sūryaḥ | agnirna śukraḥ samidhāna āhutaḥ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-25-19)

the word शरणे (*śaraṇe*) is explained as आदित्यस्य स्थाने नभसि (*ādityasya sthāne nabhasi*): since the sky is the spacious dwelling-place of the Āditya, the word शरण (*śaraṇa*) is explained as the sky. In many contexts such as मदेम शरणे सखायः (*madema śaraṇe sakhāyaḥ*) (7-19-8) the meaning "dwelling-house" is the established one.

दक्षिणाभिः (*dakṣiṇābhiḥ*)—सत्वान् दक्षयतीत्यनेन इति दक्षिणा (*satvān dakṣayatītyanena iti dakṣiṇā*): because it is the means of increasing the power of sacrifices and similar rites, it is called दक्षिणा (*dakṣiṇā*); the Kauṣītaki Brāhmaṇa gives this explanation of the word (Kau. Brā. 15-1[?241]). The relation between sacrifice and dakṣiṇā is stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā thus:

यज्ञो दक्षिणा मभ्यध्यायत्ताग्ं समभवत् । (*yajño dakṣiṇā mabhyadhyāyattāgṃ samabhavat |*)

(Tai. Saṃ. 6-1-3-6).

Just as above it was said how Indra entered the womb of the pair when the sacrifice-person, desiring relation with speech, entered conjugal relation with her, so here too the relation between sacrifice and dakṣiṇā is stated in the same way.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

बृह॑स्पते जु॒षस्व॑ नो ह॒व्यानि॑ विश्वदेव्य ।
रास्व॒ रत्ना॑नि दा॒शुषे॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *bṛhaspate juṣasva no havyāni viśvadevya |*
> *rāsva ratnāni dāśuṣe ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> बृहस्पते । जुषस्व । नः । हव्यानि । विश्वदेव्य ।
> रास्व । रत्नानि । दाशुषे ॥ ४ ॥

> *bṛhaspate | juṣasva | naḥ | havyāni | viśvadevya |*
> *rāsva | ratnāni | dāśuṣe ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वदेव्य सर्वदेवहित हे बृहस्पते नोऽस्मत्संबंधीनि हव्यानि हवनयोग्यानि पुरोडाशादीनि हवींषि जुषस्व । सेवस्व । ततस्त्वं दाशुषे हविर्दत्तवते
> यजमानाय मह्यं रत्नान्युत्तमानि धनानि रास्व। देहि ॥ रास्व। रा दाने। व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं ॥

> *viśvadevya sarvadevahita he bṛhaspate no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhīni havyāni havanayogyāni puroḍāśādīni havīṃṣi juṣasva | sevasva | tatastvaṃ dāśuṣe havirdattavate*
> *yajamānāya mahyaṃ ratnānyuttamāni dhanāni rāsva| dehi ‖ rāsva| rā dāne| vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Bṛhaspati, benevolent to all the gods, accept our oblations, that is, the offerings fit for the fire, such as the puroḍāśa cake and the other havis. Having accepted them, give precious, excellent riches to me, the sacrificer who has given the oblation. The root रा (*rā*) means "to give", and the ātmanepada form रास्व (*rāsva*) is explained as a vyatyaya (an irregular exchange of voice).

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वदेव्य (*viśvadevya*)—one who brings welfare to all
- बृहस्पते (*bṛhaspate*)—O Bṛhaspati
- नः (*naḥ*)—given by us
- हव्यानि (*havyāni*)—the oblations
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—partake of
- दाशुषे (*dāśuṣe*)—to the sacrificer who offers the oblation
- रत्नानि (*ratnāni*)—riches in the form of jewels
- रास्व (*rāsva*)—give

Gist

O Bṛhaspati, who brings welfare to all gods and men, partake of the oblations given by us. Provide wealth to the sacrificer who offers the oblation.

English translation

Brihaspati, friend of all the gods, accept our oblations: grant precious treasures to the offerer.

Special Topics

Bṛhaspati, qualified by the epithet विश्वदेव्य बृहस्पते (*viśvadevya bṛhaspate*), is praised and prayed to for his favour. विश्वदेव्य (*viśvadevya*) can mean either "one connected with the Viśvedevas" or "one beneficial to all the gods". Being beneficial to all is the very nature of Bṛhaspati; the nirvacana (etymological explanation) of this word shows it.

बृहस्पतिः बृहतः पाता ना पालयिता ना । (*bṛhaspatiḥ bṛhataḥ pātā nā pālayitā nā |*) (Ni. 10-11)

बृहंतौ पाति यल्लोकौ एष द्वौ मध्यमोत्तमौ । बृहता कर्मणा तेन बृहस्पतिरितीळितः ॥ (*bṛhaṃtau pāti yallokau eṣa dvau madhyamottamau | bṛhatā karmaṇā tena bṛhaspatiritīḷitaḥ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 2-39)

The name Bṛhaspati arises either because he fully protects the great middle and highest worlds, or because he is the performer of a great rite. बृहत् इति महतो नामदेयं (*bṛhat iti mahato nāmadeyaṃ*) (Ni. 17): "bṛhat" is the name of what is great. The meaning is that he protects all the worlds, which are of great nature. The Nirukta authors have described Bṛhaspati as a deity belonging to the world of Indra (the middle world).

इंद्राश्रयस्तु पर्जन्यो रुद्रो वायुर्बृहस्पतिः । वरुणः कश्च मृत्युश्च देवश्च ब्रह्मणस्पतिः ॥ (*iṃdrāśrayastu parjanyo rudro vāyurbṛhaspatiḥ | varuṇaḥ kaśca mṛtyuśca devaśca brahmaṇaspatiḥ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 1-122)

Parjanya, Rudra, Vāyu, Bṛhaspati, Varuṇa, Ka, Mṛtyu and the god Brahmaṇaspati: all of these are deities in the world of Indra, included within Indra and of Indra's nature. The Bṛhaddevatā also states this, following the divisions of the Nirukta authors (Ni. 5-4,5). But by this division Bṛhaspati's nature does not become restricted to a region. From the very fact that he protects all the worlds of great nature, Bṛhaspati's great nature is also understood.

एकविग्ंशतिं वशा अनूबंध्या आलभते मैत्रावरुणीर्वैश्वदेवीर्बार्हस्पत्या एतासां देवतानामाप्त्यै तद्यद्बार्हस्पत्यान्ता भवंति ब्रह्म वै बृहस्पतिस्तदु ब्रह्मण्येवांततः प्रतितिष्ठति ॥ (*ekavigṃśatiṃ vaśā anūbaṃdhyā ālabhate maitrāvaruṇīrvaiśvadevīrbārhaspatyā etāsāṃ devatānāmāptyai tadyadbārhaspatyāntā bhavaṃti brahma vai bṛhaspatistadu brahmaṇyevāṃtataḥ pratitiṣṭhati ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 13 5-4-25)

After the oblation called udayanīya, if one performs the rite called paśubandha, which is helpful to Mitrāvaruṇa, the Viśvedevas and Bṛhaspati, in order to obtain the favour of these deities, they are satisfied. That Bṛhaspati's name is placed at the end here shows that Bṛhaspati is the deity worthy of the homage of all. This Bṛhaspati is the Supreme Brahman; Bṛhaspati reflects the Brahman principle that pervades the world. In this way Bṛhaspati's greatness is shown.

The relation between Bṛhaspati and the Viśvedevas is also close. The epithet विश्वदेव्य (*viśvadevya*) too indicates it. Other śrutis also say the same. For example,

ते देवा अबिभयुरस्माकं विप्रेमाणमन्विदमसुरा अभविष्यंतीति ते प्युत्क्रम्यामंत्रयंताग्निर्वसुभिरुदक्रामदिंद्रो रुद्रैर्वरुण आदित्यैर्बृहस्पतिर्विश्वैर्देवैः ॥ (*te devā abibhayurasmākaṃ vipremāṇamanvidamasurā abhaviṣyaṃtīti te pyutkramyāmaṃtrayaṃtāgnirvasubhirudakrāmadiṃdro rudrairvaruṇa ādityairbṛhaspatirviśvairdevaiḥ ‖*) (Ai. Brā. 4-24)

Seeing the might of the Asuras, all the gods were afraid. Seeking a remedy, they all came out, thinking of the next step. Then Agni came out thinking together with the Vasus, Indra with the Rudras, Varuṇa with the Ādityas, and Bṛhaspati with the Viśvedevas. Thus the relation between Bṛhaspati and the Viśvedevas is shown.

बृहस्पतये तप्त विश्वदेव्यावते स्वाहेति । आयं वै बृहस्पतियोऽयं पवते तस्मा एवैनं जुहोति तस्मादाह बृहस्पतयेत्तेति विश्वदेव्यावत इति तदस्मिन् विश्वान्स्वर्वान् देवानन्नाभजति । (*bṛhaspataye tapta viśvadevyāvate svāheti | āyaṃ vai bṛhaspatiyo 'yaṃ pavate tasmā evainaṃ juhoti tasmādāha bṛhaspatayetteti viśvadevyāvata iti tadasmin viśvānsvarvān devānannābhajati |*) (Śa. Brā. 14-2-20)

Bṛhaspati is the form of the wind, all-pervading and spread through every region. The offering is to be made addressed to this Bṛhaspati, together with the Viśvedevas. For that very reason the offering must be made reciting the mantra beginning बृहस्पतिये त्वा (*bṛhaspatiye tvā*); then it is as though offered to Bṛhaspati together with the Viśvedevas. Thus their relation is shown. The all-pervading wind, and the principle of sound (śabda) that reflects the wind-principle, are both marked by the name Bṛhaspati.

एष उ एव बृहस्पतिः । वाग्वै बृहती, तस्या एष पतिः । तस्मादु बृहस्पतिः । (*eṣa u eva bṛhaspatiḥ | vāgvai bṛhatī, tasyā eṣa patiḥ | tasmādu bṛhaspatiḥ |*) (Bṛ. U. 1-3-20)

Bṛhaspati is the Word-Brahman. How? Speech is Bṛhatī, and this deity is the lord of speech; therefore he is renowned as Bṛhaspati. In this manner Bṛhaspati is described.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शुचिं॑म॒र्कैर्बृह॒स्पतिं॑मध्व॒रेषुं॑ नमस्यत ।
अना॒म्योज॒ आ चं॑के ॥ ५ ॥

> *śucimarkairbṛhaspatimadhvareṣu namasyata |*
> *anāmyoja ā cake ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शुचिं । अर्कैः । बृहस्पतिं । अध्वरेषु । नमस्यत ।
> अनामि । ओजः । आ । चके ॥ ५ ॥

> *śuciṃ | arkaiḥ | bṛhaspatiṃ | adhvareṣu | namasyata |*
> *anāmi | ojaḥ | ā | cake ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋत्विजो यूयमध्वरेषु शुचिं शुद्धं बृहस्पतिमर्क्करर्चनीयैः
> स्तोत्रैर्नमस्यत । परिचरत । अनाम्यनमनशीलं परैरनभिभवनीयमोजस्तस्य बलमा
> चके । सर्वतो याचे ॥ बृहस्पतिं । वनस्पत्यादित्वादुभयपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । चके ।
> कर्मेर्लिट्युत्तमे मकारलोपश्रांदसः ॥

> *he ṛtvijo yūyamadhvareṣu śuciṃ śuddhaṃ bṛhaspatimarkkararcanīyaiḥ*
> *stotrairnamasyata | paricarata | anāmyanamanaśīlaṃ*
> *parairanabhibhavanīyamojastasya balamā*
> *cake | sarvato yāce ‖ bṛhaspatiṃ |*
> *vanaspatyāditvādubhayapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | cake |*
> *karmerliṭyuttame makāralopaśrāṃdasaḥ ‖*

Summary

O priests, in the sacrifices worship the pure Bṛhaspati with praise-hymns fit to be chanted (arka); serve him. अनामि (*anāmi*) means unbending, that which others cannot overpower; his ओजः (*ojaḥ*) is his strength. आ चके(*ā cake*) means "I ask for it on every side". The word Bṛhaspati has the accent of both members of the compound, because it belongs to the vanaspati-type compounds. चके(*cake*) is the perfect of the root kṛ in the first person, with the loss of the letter m, which is Vedic.

Word-to-word meaning

- अध्वरेषु (*adhvareṣu*)—in the sacrifices
- शुचिं (*śuciṃ*)—the pure
- बृहस्पतिं (*bṛhaspatiṃ*)—Bṛhaspati
- अर्कैः (*arkaiḥ*)—with venerable praises
- नमस्यत (*namasyata*)—worship
- अनामि (*anāmi*)—that which enemies cannot diminish
- ओजः (*ojaḥ*)—strength
- आ चके(*ā cake*)—I ask (from him)

Gist

O priests, in the sacrifices worship the pure Bṛhaspati with venerable praises. I ask from him strength that enemies cannot diminish.

English translation

Adore the pure Brihaspati at sacrifices with hymns : I solicit of him unsurpassable strength.

Special Topics

अध्वरेषु शुचिं (*adhvareṣu śuciṃ*)—"pure in the sacrifices": this describes the nature of Bṛhaspati. When the epithet "pure" (śuci) is applied to the sacrificial fire there is a special meaning, and it indicates a special quality of Agni. For example,

अग्निशुचिर्व्रततमशुचिर्विप्रः शुचिः कविः । शुची रोचत आहुतः । उदग्ने शुचयस्तव शुक्रा भ्राजंत ईरते । तव ज्योतीगंष्यर्चयः ॥ (*agniśucirvratatamaśucirvipraḥ śuciḥ kaviḥ | śucī rocata āhutaḥ | udagne śucayastava śukrā bhrājaṃta īrate | tava jyotīgaṃṣyarcayaḥ ‖*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-3-14-8)

All the observances of Agni are pure. He is a pure sage (vipra), a pure poet (kavi). When the oblation is offered he shines by this very purity. O Agni, your flames, pure and bright, shine and rise with radiance. In this way the distinction of Agni, who is of the nature of radiance, with a body of flame kindled by ghee, stainless and shining, is praised. To show that the same radiance is in Bṛhaspati, the epithet "pure" is used here. Or else, since Bṛhaspati is a portion of Agni, this epithet is quite proper. In the Ṛk-saṃhitā itself there are many statements showing the identity of Agni and Bṛhaspati. For example,

अच्छा वदा तना गिरा जराय्के ब्रह्मणस्पतिं । अग्निं मित्रं न दर्शतं ॥ (*acchā vadā tanā girā jarāykè brahmaṇaspatiṃ | agniṃ mitraṃ na darśataṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-38-13)

The scholar Max Müller has translated this Ṛk thus: "Speak out for ever, with thy voice to praise the lord of prayer, Agni, who is like a friend, the bright one." The meaning given is: recite the praise of Agni, the lord of hymns, who is like a friend. That is, it shows that the word Bṛhaspati is an epithet of Agni; the meaning is that Agni is Bṛhaspati. [Sāyaṇa has explained Bṛhaspati as Maruddaṇa. That is one view. But to say that it is an epithet of Agni is the proper one here.]

तं शुभ्रमग्निमवसे हवामहे वैश्वानरं मातरिश्वानमुक्थ्यं । बृहस्पतिं मनुषो देवतातये विप्रं श्रोतारमतिथिं रघुष्यदं ॥ (*taṃ śubhramagnimavase havāmahe vaiśvānaraṃ mātariśvānamukthyaṃ | bṛhaspatiṃ manuṣo devatātaye vipraṃ śrotāramatithiṃ raghuṣyadaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-26-2)

In this mantra, which says "we call, for our protection, Agni, friend of men, worthy of praise, Mātariśvan, Bṛhaspati", Sāyaṇa too explains बृहस्पतिं (*bṛhaspatiṃ*) precisely in the sense of Agni: बृहतः यज्ञस्य पालयितारं (*bṛhataḥ yajñasya pālayitāraṃ*), "Agni, protector of the great sacrifice".

आ वेधसं नीलपृष्ठं बृहंतं बृहस्पतिं सदने साधयध्वं । सादद्योनिं दम आ दीदिवांसं हिरण्यवर्णमरुषं सपेम ॥ ((*ā vedhasaṃ nīlapṛṣṭhaṃ bṛhaṃtaṃ bṛhaspatiṃ sadane sādhayadhvaṃ | sādadyoniṃ dama ā dīdivāṃsaṃ hiraṇyavarṇamaruṣaṃ sapema ‖ ()* (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-43-12)

Here Sāyaṇa, explaining this mantra as referring to Agni, says: बृहतः परिवृढस्य कर्मणः स्वामीति बृहस्पतिरग्नि रुच्यते। तथा नीलवर्णधूमपृष्ठत्वसदनसादनहिरण्यवर्णत्वादिलिंगैरप्यग्निरेव बृहस्पतिः । (*bṛhataḥ parivṛḍhasya karmaṇaḥ svāmīti bṛhaspatiragni rucyate| tathā nīlavarṇadhūmapṛṣṭhatvasadanasādanahiraṇyavarṇatvādiliṃgairapyagnireva bṛhaspatiḥ |*) Because he is the lord of very great rites, Agni is denoted by the word Bṛhaspati. The epithets "blue-backed", "golden-coloured" and the like also describe the qualities of Agni in the form of Bṛhaspati; this he has stated exactly.

The phrase अर्कैः नमस्यत (*arkaiḥ namasyata*) also supports the above meaning. The Aitareya-Āraṇyaka mantra अग्निर्वा अर्कः (*agnirvā arkaḥ*) (Ai. Ā. 1-4-1) and

एषोऽग्निरर्को यत्पुरुषः स यो हैतमेवमग्निमर्कं पुरुषमुपास्तेय महमग्निरर्कोऽस्मीति विद्यया हैवास्यैष आत्मन्नग्निरर्कश्चितो धवति ॥ (*eṣo 'gnirarko yatpuruṣaḥ sa yo haitamevamagnimarkaṃ puruṣamupāsteya mahamagnirarko 'smīti vidyayā haivāsyaiṣa ātmannagnirarkaścito dhavati ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 10-3-4-5)

state the identity: Agni in the form of the Puruṣa is Arka; Agni in the form of the fire-altar (citi) is also Arka. [The special meanings of arka have been explained in detail in Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, part 12, p. 445.]

Here only the relation between Agni, in the form of Bṛhaspati, and Arka is indicated, showing the propriety of the use of the words "pure" (śuci) and "arka" in the present Ṛk. Just as the word śuci shows Bṛhaspati's sacrificial nature, the synonym śukra shows his spiritual nature.

बृहस्पतिर्वै शुक्रो भूत्वेदस्याभयायासुरेभ्यः क्षयायेमामविद्यामसृजत् (*bṛhaspatirvai śukro bhūtvedasyābhayāyāsurebhyaḥ kṣayāyemāmavidyāmasṛjat*) (Maitrya. Panisat. 7-9)[?242]

Bṛhaspati, becoming Śukra, created for the gods the light of knowledge and for the Asuras the darkness of ignorance. Just as the word śuci shows a special quality of Agni, so the word śukra too shows a special quality of Agni. This quality of Śukra became famous in the Purāṇas and elsewhere as Śukrācārya. This name shows spiritual truth rather than historical fact.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वृ॒ष॒भं च॑र्षणी॒नां वि॒श्वरू॑प॒मदा॑भ्यम् ।
बृ॒ह॒स्पतिं॒ वरे॑ण्यम् ॥ ६ ॥

> *vṛṣabhaṃ carṣaṇīnāṃ viśvarūpamadābhyam |*
> *bṛhaspatiṃ vareṇyam ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वृषभं । चर्षणीनां । विश्वरूपं । अदाभ्यं ।
> बृहस्पतिं । वरेण्यं ॥ ६ ॥

> *vṛṣabhaṃ | carṣaṇīnāṃ | viśvarūpaṃ | adābhyaṃ |*
> *bṛhaspatiṃ | vareṇyaṃ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> चर्षणीनां मनुष्याणां वृषभमभिमतफलवर्षकं विश्वरूपं व्याप्तरूपं ।
> यद्वा । विश्वरूपानामकगोवाहनोपेतं । तथा च मंत्रवर्णः । बृहस्पतिर्विश्वरूपामुपाजत । ऋग्वे. १–१६१–६ । इति । अदाभ्यं केनाप्यतिरस्करणीयं वरेण्यं

> सर्वैर्भजनीयं बृहस्पतिं । अभिमतफलं याच इति पूर्वणान्वयः ॥ विश्वरूपं ।
> बहुव्रीहौ विश्वं संज्ञायामिति पूर्वपदांतोदात्तत्वं । यद्वा । विश्वरूपास्य सतीति
> अर्शआदिश्वादच् प्रत्ययः । मरुद्वृधादित्वात्पूर्वपदांतोदात्तत्वं । अदाभ्यं ।
> दभेश्चेति वक्तव्यमिति ण्यत्पत्ययः ॥

> *carṣaṇīnāṃ manuṣyāṇāṃ vṛṣabhamabhimataphalavarṣakaṃ*
> *viśvarūpaṃ vyāptarūpaṃ |*
> *yadvā | viśvarūpānāmakagovāhanopetaṃ | tathā ca maṃtravarṇaḥ |*
> *bṛhaspatirviśvarūpāmupājata | ṛgve. 1-161-6 | iti | adābhyaṃ*
> *kenāpyatiraskaraṇīyaṃ vareṇyaṃ*
> *sarvairbhajanīyaṃ bṛhaspatiṃ | abhimataphalaṃ yāca iti*
> *pūrvaṇānvayaḥ ‖ viśvarūpaṃ |*
> *bahuvrīhau viśvaṃ saṃjñāyāmiti pūrvapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ | yadvā |*
> *viśvarūpāsya satīti*
> *arśaādiśvādac pratyayaḥ | marudvṛdhāditvātpūrvapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ |*
> *adābhyaṃ |*
> *dabheśceti vaktavyamiti ṇyatpatyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

Bṛhaspati is the bull (the showerer of desired fruits) of the चर्षणीनां (*carṣaṇīnāṃ*), the men; विश्वरूपं (*viśvarūpaṃ*) means "of all-pervading form". Or else, he is "accompanied by a cow-vehicle named Viśvarūpā". The mantra text says so: बृहस्पतिर्विश्वरूपामुपाजत (*bṛhaspatirviśvarūpāmupājata*) (Ṛg. 1-161-6). अदाभ्यं (*adābhyaṃ*) means "not to be slighted by anyone"; वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*) means "to be served by all". "I ask Bṛhaspati for the desired fruit": the construction links with the earlier verse. The remaining discussion concerns the accent of विश्वरूपं (*viśvarūpaṃ*) (in a bahuvrīhi, initial-member final-udātta; or, in the alternative, with the affix ac after the arśa-ādi group) and the formation of अदाभ्यं (*adābhyaṃ*) with the affix ṇyat.

Word-to-word meaning

- चर्षणीनां (*carṣaṇīnāṃ*)—to men
- वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—the giver of desired things
- विश्वरूपं (*viśvarūpaṃ*)—the one of many forms
- अदाभ्यं (*adābhyaṃ*)—the one who is rejected by no one

- वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*)—the one worthy of the worship of all
- बृहस्पतिं (*bṛhaspatiṃ*)—Bṛhaspati (I beseech)

Gist

I beseech Bṛhaspati, who gives desired things to men, who has many forms, who is rejected by no one, and who is worthy of the worship of all.

English translation

The showerer (of benefits) on men, the omniform, the irreproachable, the excellent Brihaspati.

Special Topics

Sāyaṇa has given two kinds of meaning for the epithet विश्वरूपं (*viśvarūpaṃ*). First, व्याप्तरूपं (*vyāptarūpaṃ*): one whose form pervades all regions. Second, यद्वा निश्वरूपानाम गोवाहनोपेतं (*yadvā niśvarūpānāma govāhanopetaṃ*): one who has as his vehicle the cow named Viśvarūpa. Both kinds of explanation describe the nature of Bṛhaspati.

Earlier it was explained, in एष उ एव बृहस्पतिः (*eṣa u eva bṛhaspatiḥ*) and वाग्वै बृहस्पतिः (*vāgvai bṛhaspatiḥ*), that Speech, which is all-pervading, is Bṛhaspati; that the Udgītha, which has many forms such as Aṅgirasa and Ayāsya and is all-pervading, is Bṛhaspati; and that Agni, who pervades the universe through names and forms such as Vaiśvānara, is Bṛhaspati. That showed Bṛhaspati's all-pervasiveness. Here the propriety of this epithet must be examined through the explanation विश्वरूपानामगोवाहनोपेतं (*viśvarūpānāmagovāhanopetaṃ*).

अरुण्यो गाव उषसां । श्यावा सवितुः । विश्वरूपा बृहस्पतेः ॥ (*aruṇyo gāva uṣasāṃ | śyāvā savituḥ | viśvarūpā bṛhaspateḥ ‖*) (Ni. 2-28). Just as the horses called Harī are well known for Indra, the ruddy cows for Uṣas, the goats for Pūṣan, and likewise vehicles suited to the other deities, so for Bṛhaspati the cow called Viśvarūpā is well known as the vehicle. Sāyaṇa too cites the passage बृहस्पतेर्विश्वरूपामुपाजत (*bṛhaspaterviśvarūpāmupājata*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-161-6) and says that, as Viśvarūpā there means the cow of that name, so here too the sense is "one who has the cow named Viśvarūpa". However, while explaining Ṛk 1-161-6 he also raises the doubt why the word विश्वरूपां (*viśvarūpāṃ*) should be taken as meaning a cow, and gives the answer.

धेनुं सबर्दुघां चक्रुरमृतं सबरुच्यते । बृहस्पतेरथाश्विभ्यां रथं दिव्यं त्रिवंधुरं ॥ (*dhenuṃ sabardughāṃ cakruramṛtaṃ sabarucyate | bṛhaspaterathāśvibhyāṃ rathaṃ divyaṃ trivaṃdhuraṃ ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 3-85, 86). This says that the Ṛbhus made for Bṛhaspati a cow that yields nectar. The name Viśvarūpā is not mentioned. Some hold that this cow is the goddess of Speech, that the varieties of Speech, which has many natures, are what has all forms, and that Speech, which has the nature of the supreme Brahman, is the nectar. Scriptural statements can be shown in support of this purport as well.

. यद्यप्यत्र गौरिति विशेषो न श्रुतः तथापि पूर्वं धेनुं कर्त्वा इत्युत्तत्वात् परस्ताच्च ये धेनुं विश्वजुवं विश्वरूपां इति वक्ष्यमाणत्वाच्च विश्वरूपा गौः इत्येवाध्यवसीयते ॥ (*. yadyapyatra gauriti viśeṣo na śrutaḥ tathāpi pūrvaṃ dhenuṃ kartvā ityuttatvāt parastācca ye dhenuṃ viśvajuvaṃ viśvarūpāṃ iti vakṣyamāṇatvācca viśvarūpā gauḥ ityevādhyavasīyate ‖*). In the present verse there is no qualified noun "cow". Still, because the making of a cow was mentioned before (1-161-3), and because later too the creation of a cow is stated with विश्वरूपां (*viśvarūpāṃ*), the sense here too must be "cow". So Sāyaṇa explains Ṛk 1-161-6.

Moreover:

रथं ये चक्रुः सुवृतं नरेष्ठां ये धेनुं विश्वजुवं विश्वरूपां । त आ तक्षन्त्वृभवो रयिं नः स्ववसः स्वपसः सुहस्ताः ॥ (*rathaṃ ye cakruḥ suvṛtaṃ nareṣṭhāṃ ye dhenuṃ viśvajuvaṃ viśvarūpāṃ | ta ā takṣantvṛbhavo rayiṃ naḥ svavasaḥ svapasaḥ suhastāḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-33-8).

Here it is clear that the Ṛbhus created for Bṛhaspati the cow called Viśvarūpā. The same point is made in the present verse, and Bṛhaspati's nature is described by the epithet विश्वरूपं (*viśvarūpaṃ*).

वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*)—संभजनीयं (*saṃbhajanīyaṃ*): Bṛhaspati, who is worthy of worship; Bṛhaspati is worthy of worship for all the gods and for men.

ब्रह्म हि बृहस्पतिर्ब्रह्म हि ब्राह्मणाः (*brahma hi bṛhaspatirbrahma hi brāhmaṇāḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 5-1-5-6).

ब्रह्म वै बृहस्पतिर्ब्रह्मणैवैनं तद्भिषज्यति (*brahma vai bṛhaspatirbrahmaṇaivainaṃ tadbhiṣajyati*) (Ai. Brā. 4-19).

In such passages Bṛhaspati's worthiness of worship is praised. Here the favour of Bṛhaspati, who has such greatness, is prayed for.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒यं ते॑ पूषन्नाघृणे सुष्टु॒तिर्दे॑व॒ नव्यं॑सी ।
अ॒स्माभि॒स्तुभ्यं॑ शस्यते ॥ ७ ॥

> *iyaṃ te pūṣannāghṛṇe suṣṭutirdeva navyasī |*
> *asmābhistubhyaṃ śasyate ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इयं । ते । पूषन् । आफृणे । सुस्तुतिः । देव । नव्यसी ।
> अस्माभिः । तुभ्यं । शस्यते ॥ ७ ॥

> *iyaṃ | te | pūṣan | āphṛṇe | sustutiḥ | deva | navyasī |*
> *asmābhiḥ | tubhyaṃ | śasyate ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आघ्रणे आगतदीप्तिमन् हे पूषन् देव नव्यसी नवतरेयं सुष्टुतिः शोभ
> नस्तुतिरूपा वाक् ते त्वत्संबंधिनी भवति । सैषा स्तुतिरस्माभिः स्तोतृभिस्तुभ्यं
> त्वदर्थं शस्यते । तां जुषस्वेत्युत्तरेणान्वयः ॥

> *āghraṇe āgatadīptiman he pūṣan deva navyasī navatareyaṃ suṣṭutiḥ śobha*
> *nastutirūpā vāk te tvatsaṃbaṃdhinī bhavati | saiṣā stutirasmābhiḥ stotṛbhistubhyaṃ*
> *tvadarthaṃ śasyate | tāṃ juṣasvetyuttareṇānvayaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Āghṛṇi (one whose radiance has arrived), O Pūṣan, O god: this newer, fresh laudation, a speech of praise that is beautiful, is yours, related to you. This praise is uttered by us, the praisers, for you, for your sake. The construction is with the following verse: "Enjoy it."

Word-to-word meaning

- आघृणे (*āghṛṇe*)—O shining one
- पूषन् देव (*pūṣan deva*)—O god Pūṣan
- नव्यसी (*navyasī*)—new
- इयं सुष्टुतिः (*iyaṃ suṣṭutiḥ*)—and excellent, this praise
- ते (*te*)—to be offered to you
- अस्माभिः (*asmābhiḥ*)—by us, the praisers
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—addressed to you
- शस्यते (*śasyate*)—is praised

Gist

O shining god Pūṣan, this praise, new and excellent, is to be offered to you. It has been composed by us, the praisers, in your honour.

English translation

Divine, resplendent, Pushan, this, your most recent laudation, is uttered by us to you.

Special Topics

पूषन् (*pūṣan*)—पूषा यद्रश्मिपोषं पुष्यति तत् पूषा भवति (*pūṣā yadraśmipoṣaṃ puṣyati tat pūṣā bhavati*) (Ni. 12-16). The author of the Nirukta has shown this derivation of the word: since he nourishes the world, attaining an abundance of rays, he is named Pūṣā. To show that this definition is fitting, the Nirukta-writer has cited as authority a passage of the Ṛk Saṃhitā.

शुक्रंते अन्यद्यजतं ते अन्यद्विषुरूपे अहनी द्यौरिवासि । विश्वा हि माया अवसि स्वधावो भद्रा ते पूषन्निह रातिरस्तु ॥ (*śukraṃ te anyadyajataṃ te anyadviṣurūpe ahanī dyaurivāsi | viśvā hi māyā avasi svadhāvo bhadrā te pūṣanniha rātirastu ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-58-1).

O Pūṣan, you possess a variety of radiance. Day and night are all the effect of your radiance. All your actions filled with wisdom also point to the power of the Sun. You are one who possesses exceedingly great radiance. Thus a Ṛk describing Pūṣan's quality is cited, showing that radiance is his special quality.

पुष्यन् क्षितिं पोषयति प्रणुदन् रश्मिभिस्तमः । तेनैनमस्तौत्पोषेति भरद्वाजस्तु पंचभिः ॥ (*puṣyan kṣitiṃ poṣayati praṇudan raśmibhistamaḥ | tenainamastautpoṣeti bharadvājastu paṃcabhiḥ ||*) (Bṛ. De. 2-63).

He is called Pūṣā because, destroying darkness with his mass of radiance, he nourishes the earth so that it attains fullness. The seer Bharadvāja praised Pūṣan with hymns addressed to this god, in five sūktas. The authors of the Bṛhaddevatā state that in that context all of Pūṣan's good qualities are described.

इयं वै पूषा पूषेयं हीवं सर्वं पुष्यति यदिदं किंच । (*iyaṃ vai pūṣā pūṣeyaṃ hīvaṃ sarvaṃ puṣyati yadidaṃ kiṃca |*) (Śa. Brā. 14-4-2-25).

In the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa his nature is described thus: he is called Pūṣan because he nourishes all things. There is room for discussion on whether Pūṣan is only one of the twelve Ādityas or an independent deity distinct from them.

यास्ते पूषन्नावो अंतः समुद्रे हिरण्ययिरंतरिक्षे चरंति । ताभिर्यासि दूत्यां सूर्यस्य कामेन कृत श्रव इच्छमानः ॥ (*yāste pūṣannāvo aṃtaḥ samudre hiraṇyayiraṃtarikṣe caraṃti | tābhiryāsi dūtyāṃ sūryasya kāmena kṛta śrava icchamānaḥ ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-58-3).

O Pūṣan, the beneficial, ray-formed boat of yours that sails in the ocean of the atmosphere: together with that ray-formed boat you act as the Sun's messenger. From such passages it is shown that points of difference between the Sun and Pūṣan appear. In Sūkta 8-29 of the Ṛ. Saṃ., where the nature of the Viśvedevas is described, no solar quality is specified in the description of Pūṣan. So it is argued that, contrary to the traditional view, Pūṣan is not an Āditya deity; he is a deity of "herdsman" nature who has obtained a distinct character of his own.

The main part of the hymns to the deity Pūṣan is in the sixth Maṇḍala of the Ṛk Saṃhitā. As stated in the Bṛhaddevatā, it appears that the seers of the Bhāradvāja line took Pūṣan as their chief deity. Some call this portion the Pūṣa-saṃhitā. Besides, in other parts of the Saṃhitā too Pūṣan is praised, together with other deities such as Indra and Soma. Descriptions such as Kaparda, Paśusādhanī, Aṣṭrā, Karambhād and Ajāśva give a definite picture of Pūṣan. Along with the ordinary qualities that other deities also have, a special aspect of Pūṣan seems to be prominent in the sixth Maṇḍala. It is stated plainly that he is the deity who protects herds, that by the grace of this deity the cattle-wealth of worshippers should increase, and that he is the protector of cattle that have lost their way.

पूषा गा अन्वेतु नः पूषा रक्षत्वर्वतः । पूषा वाजं सनोतु नः ॥ (*pūṣā gā anvetu naḥ pūṣā rakṣatvarvataḥ | pūṣā vājaṃ sanotu naḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-54-5).

मार्किर्नेशन्मार्कीं रिषन्मार्कीं सं शारि केवटे । अथारिष्टाभिरा गहि । (*mārkirneśanmākīṃ riṣanmākīṃ saṃ śāri kevaṭe | athāriṣṭābhirā gahi |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-54-7).

Thus, praying in many ways, they pray that their cattle-wealth be increased.

From the above examples, though Pūṣan may be called an independent deity, it is not possible to say that he is distinct from the twelve Ādityas; and to say so would be wrong. For, although epithets such as protector of cattle show Pūṣan's distinctness, he is described as a deity who is a mass of radiance, just as the deities Sūrya, Aryaman, Bhaga and others are described. Yāska counts Pūṣan as one of the twelve Ādityas. The scholar Bloomfield too, following Yāska's view, maintains, on the basis of the epithet आफृणि (*āphṛṇi*) in Ṛks such as Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-48.16; 6-53-6; 6-55-1, that Pūṣan is an Āditya deity who makes light shine.[?243] Some oppose this view. They argue that the word आफृणि (*āphṛṇi*), used also in the present Ṛk, can describe the quality of any radiant deity; that this epithet may be used of any deity full of radiance; that there is no rule that it must be an Āditya; that, for example (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-60-20), in some places the epithet applies to Agni; and that by this one epithet alone Pūṣan cannot be determined to be an Āditya deity. Yāska, the authors of the Bṛhaddevatā and others of the Vedic tradition maintain that आफृणि

(*āphṛṇi*) is a special quality showing Pūṣan's distinctness alone. When Yāska gives the definition of this word in the Nirukta, he explains it as आफृणिराहृतहृणिः (*āphṛṇirāhṛtahṛṇiḥ*),

and indicating the word in the Ṛk

एहि वां विमुचो नपादाघृणे सं सचावहै । रथीर्यतस्य नो भव । (*ehi vāṃ vimuco napādāghṛṇe saṃ sacāvahai | rathīryatasya no bhava |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-55-1),

he states his view. But in आगतहृणिः (*āgatahṛṇiḥ*) he has not given a precise meaning for the word हृणि (*hṛṇi*). The word हृणि (*hṛṇi*) is read among the words for brightness (Ni. 2-28) and also among the names of anger (Ni. 4-9). Therefore Durgācārya, commenting on this word, says: अफृणिशब्दो दीप्तिवाचकः । दीप्तिकर्मसु च पठित एवायं हृणिः इति (*aphṛṇiśabdo dīptivācakaḥ | dīptikarmasu ca paṭhita evāyaṃ hṛṇiḥ iti*). Since the word हृणि (*hṛṇi*) is read among words denoting brightness, one meaning is "shining"; and क्रोधोऽपि हृणिरुच्यते (*krodho 'pi hṛṇirucyate*): since the word हृणि (*hṛṇi*) also means anger, another is "let us serve that Pūṣan whose anger may be directed upon us". Thus he shows that two kinds of explanation are possible. The authors of the Bṛhaddevatā explain this epithet in yet another way.

तृचो विश्वेषां देवानां पूष्ण आघृणये तृचः । आसक्तो हि घृणिस्तस्य दध्नः पूर्णो दृती रथे ॥ आघृणिस्तत्सुतः पूषा कीरिभी रिभ्यते ततः ॥ (*tṛco viśveṣāṃ devānāṃ pūṣṇa āghṛṇaye tṛcaḥ | āsakto hi ghṛṇistasya dadhnaḥ pūrṇo dṛtī rathe || āghṛṇistatsutaḥ pūṣā kīribhī ribhyate tataḥ ||*) (Bṛ. De. 3-95, 96).

Since a leather bag filled with curds (an intoxicating liquid) is tied to his chariot, he has the name आफृणि (*āphṛṇi*); and for that very reason the poets who praise him praise Pūṣan as आफृणि (*āphṛṇi*). Generally Sāyaṇa, in all places where this word occurs, explains it as आगतदीप्ते पूषन् (*āgatadīpte pūṣan*). This word (आफृणि (*āphṛṇi*)) is an epithet of Agni only at 8-60-20. In all other places it is an epithet of Pūṣan and states his distinctness.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तां जु॑षस्व॒ गि॒रं मम॑ वा॒ज॒यन्ती॑मवा॒ धि॒यम्॑ ।
व॒धू॒युरि॑व॒ योष॑णाम् ॥ ८ ॥

> *tāṃ juṣasva giraṃ mama vājayantīmavā dhiyam |*
> *vadhūyuriva yoṣaṇām ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शां । जुषस्व । गिरं । मम । वाजयंतीं । अव । धियं ।
> वधूयुःइव । योषणां ॥ ८ ॥

> *śāṃ | juṣasva | giraṃ | mama | vājayaṃtīṃ | ava | dhiyaṃ |*
> *vadhūyuḥiva | yoṣaṇāṃ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे पूषन् स्तोत्रं कुर्वाणस्य मम तां तादृशीं गिरं स्तुतिलक्षणां वाचं
> जुषस्व । सेवस्व । स्तुत्या प्रीतस्त्वं वाजयंतीं वाजमन्नमिच्छंतीं हर्षकारिणीं
> धियमिमां स्तुतिं प्रत्यव । अभिगच्छ । तत्र दृष्टांतः । वधूयुरिव । यथा वधूयुः
> स्त्रीकामो योषणां स्त्रीयं प्रत्यागच्छति तद्वत् ॥ वाजयंतीं । वाजशब्दादिच्छतीत्यर्थे क्यच् ।
> तदंताच्छतरि जीपि रूपं । जीपोऽनुदात्तत्वे प्रत्ययस्वरः । अव ।
> अव रक्षणादिश्वित्यस्य लोटि रूपं ॥

> *he pūṣan stotraṃ kurvāṇasya mama tāṃ tādṛśīṃ giraṃ stutilakṣaṇāṃ vācaṃ*
> *juṣasva | sevasva | stutyā prītastvaṃ vājayaṃtīṃ vājamannamicchaṃtīṃ harṣakāriṇīṃ*
> *dhiyamimāṃ stutiṃ pratyava | abhigaccha | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | vadhūyuriva | yathā vadhūyuḥ*
> *strīkāmo yoṣaṇāṃ strīyaṃ pratyāgacchati tadvat ‖ vājayaṃtīṃ | vājaśabdādicchatītyarthe kyac | tadaṃtācchatari jīpi rūpaṃ | jīpo 'nudāttatve pratyayasvaraḥ | ava |*
> *ava rakṣaṇādiśvityasya loṭi rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Pūṣan, accept (जुषस्व (*juṣasva*), "serve") that speech of mine, of me who am praising, a speech whose nature is praise. Pleased by the praise, come towards this hymn (धियं (*dhiyaṃ*)), which seeks food (वाज (*vāja*), "food") and gives delight." The illustration is वधूयुरिव (*vadhūyuriva*): as a वधूयुः (*vadhūyuḥ*), one desirous of a woman, goes towards a woman (योषणां (*yoṣaṇāṃ*)), so Pūṣan is to come towards the praise. वाजयंतीं (*vājayaṃtīṃ*) is formed from the word वाज (*vāja*) in the sense "desires", and अव (*ava*) is the imperative of the root अव (*ava*) meaning "protect" and so on.

Word-to-word meaning

- Hey (Pūṣa-deva)
- मम (*mama*)—of me, who am the praiser
- अव (*ava*) is given last; see below
- तां गिरं (*tāṃ giraṃ*)—this speech, which has the form of praise
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept
- वाजयंतीं (*vājayaṃtīṃ*)—that which procures food
- धियं (*dhiyaṃ*)—this praise
- योषणां (*yoṣaṇāṃ*)—towards a woman
- वधूयुरिव (*vadhūyuriva*)—as one desirous of a woman comes
- अव (*ava*)—come to meet

Gist

O Pūṣan, accept this speech of mine, the praiser, which has the form of praise. As a man desirous of a woman comes towards a woman, so come towards this delight-giving praise, which procures food.

English translation

Be pleased by this my praise, and incline to this food-supplicating laudation as an uxorious (husband) to his wife.

Special Topics

The two words गिरं (*giraṃ*) and धियं (*dhiyaṃ*) are synonyms for "praise" here. स्तुतयो गिरः गृणातेः (*stutayo girah̤ gr̤n̤āteh̤*) (Ni. 1-11): the Nirukta-writers have shown the etymology that the word गिर् (*gir*) is derived from the root गृ (*gr̤*), which means "to make a sound". To support this, they explain it by showing the example of the word गिरः (*girah̤*), in the sense of praise, in the Ṛk तमिद्वर्थंतु नो गिरः सदावृधं (*tamidvarthaṃtu no girah̤ sadāvr̤dhaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-13-18).?[244]

धियं (*dhiyaṃ*)—this word is read among the names of works (karma).?[245] Indeed, quoting the Ṛk महो अर्णः सरस्वती प्रचेतयति केतुना । धियो विश्वा विराजति ॥ (*maho arṇaḥ sarasvatī pracetayati ketunā | dhiyo viśvā virājati ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-3-12), the Nirukta-writers explain सर्वाणि प्रज्ञानानि (*sarvāṇi prajñānāni*), that is, "all our meditations (dhyāna), full of understanding"; and since praise too is meditative and rich in understanding,

it too is denoted by the word धी (*dhī*). In some contexts the praisers, who are devoted to meditation, are also denoted by the word धी (*dhī*). In the present place धियं (*dhiyaṃ*) means "praise".

The relation between Pūṣan and the praise that has the form of धी (*dhī*) is compared with the relation between a young woman and a young man. As a well-adorned, refined and beautiful woman attracts an excellent man, so a refined praise attracts Pūṣan; this simile-description is poetic. It is not rare in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā that the love between Agni and the other gods and the oblation, between the praises and the gods, and between Indra and Soma, is likened to the bond of love between newly youthful lovers.

शये वव्रिश्चरति जिह्वयादन्नेरिह्यते युवतिं विश्वतिः सन् । (*śaye vavriścarati jihvayādanrerihyate yuvatiṃ viśvatiḥ san |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-4-4): Agni, the lord of the house and its people, embraces with his mouth of flame the young woman in the form of the oblation; or else he embraces the young woman in the form of the earth.

अयं योनिश्च कृमा यं वयं ते जायेव पत्य उशती सुवासाः । (*ayaṃ yoniśca kr̤mā yaṃ vayaṃ te jāyeva patya uśatī suvāsāḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-3-2): O Agni, as a wife is adorned with excellent garments and ornaments and is thereby satisfied, for her husband's pleasure, so for your coming we prepare this place of sacrifice, the northern altar, well refined and make it attractive to you. In the same way the attractive relation between praise and the deity is described here as well. In places such as उक्तेवायुस्य रण्यसि (*ukte vāyusya raṇyasi*) (8-12-18) and यस्मिन्नु कानि रण्यंति विश्वानि च श्रवस्या (*yasminnu kāni raṇyaṃti viśvāni ca śravasyā*) (8-16-2), Indra and the others taking delight joined with the praises, and the praises taking delight joined with Indra and the other gods, are described in an attractive manner. Situations in which this delight and satisfaction are likened to the joy and satisfaction arising from the attractive union of newly youthful lovers are very plentiful, as in those cited above. In the present Ṛk too, explaining the same point, the praise is likened to a beautiful woman and Pūṣan to a young man so desirous of a woman. That is, the purport is that the praiser's praise is adorned and refined in such a way as to attract Pūṣan.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यो विश्वा॒भि वि॒पश्य॑ति॒ भुव॑ना॒ सं च॒ पश्य॑ति ।
स नः॑ पू॒षावि॒ता भु॑वत् ॥ ९ ॥

> *yo viśvābhi vipaśyati bhuvanā saṃ ca paśyati |*
> *sa naḥ pūṣāvitā bhuvat ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । विश्वा । अभि । विपश्यति । भुवना । सं । च । पश्यति ।
> सः । नः । पूषा । अविता । भुवत् ॥ ९ ॥

> *yaḥ | viśvā | abhi | vipaśyati | bhuvanā | saṃ | ca | paśyati |*
> *saḥ | naḥ | pūṣā | avitā | bhuvat ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यः पूषा विश्वा भुवना सर्वाल्लोकानभि अभिमुख्येन विपश्यति विशेषेण
> पश्यति । किंच तानि सं पश्यति तत्तद्वस्तुयाथात्म्यं सम्यक् जानाति । स तादृशः पूषा
> देवो नोऽस्माकमविता रक्षको भुवत् । भवतु ॥ विपश्यति । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । शपः
> पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । तिजि चोदात्तवतीति गतेर्निघातः ।
> पश्यति । अत्र सकर्मकत्वात्परस्मैपदं । पूर्ववदनिघातः । भवत् । भवतेर्लेट्ट्यडागमः ।
> भूसुवोस्तिजीति गुणप्रतिषेध उवजादेशः । निघातः ॥

> *yaḥ pūṣā viśvā bhuvanā sarvāllokānabhi abhimukhyena vipaśyati viśeṣeṇa*
> *paśyati | kiṃca tāni saṃ paśyati tattadvastuyāthātmyaṃ samyak jānāti | sa tādṛśaḥ pūṣā*
> *devo no 'smākamavitā rakṣako bhuvat | bhavatu ‖ vipaśyati | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | śapaḥ pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | tiji codāttavatīti gaternighātaḥ |*
> *paśyati | atra sakarmakatvātparasmaipadaṃ | pūrvavadanighātaḥ | bhavat | bhavaterlèṭṭyaḍāgamaḥ | bhūsuvostijīti guṇapratiṣedha uvajādeśaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

The Pūṣan who looks upon (अभि विपश्यति (*abhi vipaśyati*)) all the worlds, all the regions, directly and in particular; and moreover (सं पश्यति (*saṃ paśyati*)) sees them thoroughly, that is, knows rightly the true nature of each thing: may that Pūṣan, the god, be our protector (अविता (*avitā*), "guardian"); भुवत् (*bhuvat*) means "may he be".

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Pūṣa-deva
- विश्वा (*viśvā*)—all
- भुवना (*bhuvanā*)—worlds
- अभि विपश्यति (*abhi vipaśyati*)—looks upon and sees (and)
- सं पश्यति (*saṃ paśyati*)—is able to know subtly the true nature of every thing
- सः (*saḥ*)—such
- पूषा (*pūṣā*)—Pūṣa-deva
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us

- अविता (*avitā*)—as protector
- भुवत् (*bhuvat*)—may he be

Gist

May that Pūṣa-deva, who looks upon and sees all the worlds and who knows subtly the real nature of every thing, be our protector.

English translation

May that Pushan, who looks upon all the worlds, who thoroughly contemplates them, be our protector.

Special Topics

The very quality of seeing the whole universe, which is described as the intrinsic quality of Savitṛ and of Āditya, is described in the present Ṛk too. By the sentence विश्वा भुवना अभि विपत्यति (*viśvā bhuvanā abhi vipatyati*)[?246] the quality of Āditya, the eye of the world, is in effect stated; that is, it was said earlier that the epithet आफृणिः (*āphṛṇiḥ*) specifically shows the Āditya-nature in Pūṣan. By this very radiance Pūṣan has the power of looking at the whole universe.

प्रपथे पथामजनिष्ट पूषा प्रपथे दिवः प्रपथे पृथिव्याः । उभे अभि प्रियतमे सदस्ये आ च परा च चरति प्रजानन् ॥ (*prapathe pathāmajaniṣṭa pūṣā prapathe divaḥ prapathe pṛthivyāḥ | ubhe abhi priyatame sadasye ā ca parā ca carati prajānan ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-17-6). The description that Pūṣan moves everywhere, watching over and protecting the paths of all the worlds, namely the path that goes to the atmosphere, the excellent path that leads to the world of heaven, and the excellent path of the earth, is itself the path of Āditya's travel through the universe. When it is said that he looks upon all such worlds, there is a repetition: अभि विपश्यति (*abhi vipaśyati*); संपश्यति (*saṃpaśyati*). For सं पश्यति (*saṃ paśyati*), तत्तद्वस्तुयाथात्मं सम्यग् जानाति (*tattadvastuyāthātmaṃ samyag jānāti*) means: he knows fully the subtle nature of those several things. Such power of right seeing is not possible for anyone but the Self of the universe; it is not to be perceived by ordinary sight. Even a knower of the truth who wishes for that power of right seeing asks only for Pūṣan's grace. Thus:

हिरण्मयेन पात्रेण सत्यस्यापिहितं मुखं । तत्त्वं पूषन्नपावृणु सत्यधर्माय दृष्टये । पूषन्नेकर्षे यम सूर्य प्राजापत्य व्यूह रश्मीन् । समूह तेजो यत्ते रूपं कल्याणतमं तत्ते पश्यामि ॥ (*hiraṇmayena pātreṇa satyasyāpihitaṃ mukhaṃ | tattvaṃ pūṣannapāvṛṇu satyadharmāya dṛṣṭaye | pūṣannekarṣe yama sūrya prājāpatya vyūha raśmīn | samūha tejo yatte rūpaṃ kalyāṇatamaṃ tatte paśyāmi ||*) (Bṛ. U. 5-15-1,2). Brahman, whose nature is truth, is covered by the disc whose form is light. O Pūṣan, I too, who am devoted to the truth (satya-dharma), ask you to remove this covering so that I may see it. O Pūṣan, you alone are the sage of the nature of truth! The Āditya, the eye of the world, is Prājāpatya. With the help of all your radiance, gather together all the truths. Grant the power to know all the truths. In this way Pūṣan, who is thus prayed to, is indeed the deity who sets forth the Āditya-principle. The seeing power of Savitṛ of such Āditya-form is shown by the sentences अभि विपश्यति (*abhi vipaśyati*), संपश्यति (*saṃpaśyati*). The prayer of the next mantra is to obtain the power of knowing the divine form of this greatly eminent Savitṛ.

Introduction to the Gāyatrī great mantra

The name Gāyatrī is well known for the tenth Ṛk of this sūkta, तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं (*tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ*). This Ṛk is read in all three Vedas: in the Ṛgveda at 3-62-10; in the Sāmaveda at 1462; in the Vājasaneyi-Saṃhitā (Śukla Yajurveda) at 3-35; 22-9; 30-2; 36-3; in the Taittirīya-Saṃhitā (Kṛṣṇa Yajurveda) at 1-5-6-4; 4-1-11-1; and in the Taittirīya-Āraṇyaka at 1-11-2. In these places this Gāyatrī mantra is read. Further, except for the Yajurveda, which is largely prose, the other three Vedas, the Ṛgveda, Sāmaveda and Atharvaṇa, all begin with Ṛks in the Gāyatrī metre.[?247]

Although in general this is the name of a metre with three pādas of eight syllables each, it has become customary to call this very Ṛk "the Gāyatrī" among all the mantras of this metre. Since the word गायत्रि (*gāyatri*) is derived from the root गै (*gai*) (to sing), the word means a Ṛk suited for singing. Therefore the greater part of the Sāmaveda, which is recited in the form of song, consists of Ṛks of the Gāyatrī metre taken from the Ṛgveda. As said in Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-10-1, the sentence

गायंति त्वा गायत्रिणः (*gāyaṃti tvā gāyatriṇaḥ*) means: O Indra, the officiating priests, such as the Udgātṛ, who sing with mantras of the Gāyatrī metre, praise you with Sāma mantras and sing.

As the Ṛgveda has the first (chief) place among the Vedas, the Gāyatrī metre has the first place among the metres. And as the Brāhmaṇa has the foremost place among the three classes, Brāhmaṇa, Kṣatriya and Vaiśya, so the Gāyatrī has the foremost place among the metres. Therefore in the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa of the Yajurveda:

गायत्रीभिर्ब्राह्मणस्यादध्यात् । गायत्रछंदा वै ब्राह्मणः । स्वस्य छंदसः प्रत्ययनस्त्वाय । (*gāyatrībhirbrāhmaṇasyādadhyāt | gāyatrachaṃdā vai brāhmaṇaḥ | svasya chaṃdasaḥ pratyayanastvāya |*)

त्रिष्टुग्भी राजन्यस्य । त्रिष्टुप्छंदा वै राजन्यः । स्वस्य छंदसः प्रत्ययनस्त्वाय । (*triṣṭugbhī rājanyasya | triṣṭupchaṃdā vai rājanyaḥ | svasya chaṃdasaḥ pratyayanastvāya |*)

जगतीभिर्वैश्यस्य । जगतीछंदा वै वैश्यः । स्वस्य छंदसः प्रत्ययनस्त्वाय । (*jagatībhirvaiśyasya | jagatīchaṃdā vai vaiśyaḥ | svasya chaṃdasaḥ pratyayanastvāya |*)

(Tai. Brā. 1-1-9-6, 7)

So it is said. That is, in the ādhāna rite (ādhāna means newly establishing the sacrificial fire) and in the other sacrificial rites the Brāhmaṇa should perform the proceedings with mantras of the Gāyatrī metre alone. For it is said that the Gāyatrī metre is the Brāhmaṇa's own metre; and

likewise the Kṣatriya (the king) should perform the proceedings at sacrifices and the like with mantras of his own metre, the Triṣṭubh, and the Vaiśya with mantras of his own metre, the Jagatī. Not only this, but in the chief acts performed in sacrifices the rite is to be performed first with mantras of the Gāyatrī metre. Thus:

गायत्रीरन्वाह गायत्रं वै प्रातस्सवनं (*gāyatrīranvāha gāyatraṃ vai prātassavanaṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 28-9)

त्रैष्टुभं वै माध्यंदिनं सवनं (*traiṣṭubhaṃ vai mādhyaṃdinaṃ savanaṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 28-10)

जागतं वै तृतीयसवनं (*jāgataṃ vai tṛtīyasavanaṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 28-15)

So it is said in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa. That is, the chief ritual parts of the sacrifice are the three savanas: the morning pressing, the midday pressing and the third pressing. Savana is the particular rite of crushing the soma plants with stones and squeezing out the juice. It must be done with mantras and as prescribed. Therefore in the morning-pressing rite performed in the morning, the act called abhiṣavaṇa, squeezing out this soma juice, is performed with mantras of the Gāyatrī metre; in the midday pressing with mantras of the Triṣṭubh metre, and in the third pressing with mantras of the Jagatī metre. Therefore, among the chief acts to be performed in a sacrifice, the mantras of the Gāyatrī metre have the pre-eminence. And if we examine the relation between deities and metres, it is said that the Gāyatrī metre is dear to Agni, the Triṣṭubh to Indra, and the Jagatī to the Viśve-devāḥ.

Since it is said अष्टाक्षरा गायत्री । गायत्री ब्रह्मवर्चसं (*aṣṭākṣarā gāyatrī | gāyatrī brahmavarcasaṃ*) (Śai. Brā. 2-3-3-9)[?248] and so on, if the Brāhmaṇa performs rites with mantras of the Gāyatrī metre he becomes endowed with Brahmanical lustre. If the king (Kṣatriya) does so with mantras of the Triṣṭubh metre, he obtains vigour, strength and fame. If the Vaiśya does so with mantras of the Jagatī metre, he obtains wealth of cattle, riches, prosperity and the like. This is said in many places in the Yajurveda.

Further, for all the 114 sūktas in the ninth maṇḍala of the Ṛgveda, Soma, called Pavamāna Soma, is the deity. But the first 67 sūktas of this maṇḍala are in the Gāyatrī metre. All these were seen by various seers. Known as the Pavamāna sūktas, they have received great pre-eminence from the time of the Vedas. Their importance and glory are described there itself:

यः पावमानीरध्येति .... सर्वं स पूतमश्नाति । (*yaḥ pāvamānīradhyeti .... sarvaṃ sa pūtamaśnāti |*)

पावमानीयो अध्येति .... । (*pāvamānīyo adhyeti .... |*)

तस्मै सरस्वती दुहे क्षीरं सर्पिर्मधूदकं । (*tasmai sarasvatī duhe kṣīraṃ sarpirmadhūdakaṃ |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-67-31, 32)

That is, whatever man studies (recites) these Pāvamānī sūktas, composed of ṛks in the Gāyatrī metre, obtains all his desired objects and prospers. The goddess Sarasvatī fulfils all his desires and also pours out milk, ghee, honey, water and every kind of abundance for him. All this is the greatness of the Gāyatrī mantra as stated in the Vedas. The precedence it has in the matter of the meaning of the Gāyatrī mantra now under discussion, and similar matters, are explained in the Special Topics of this ṛk.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तत्स॑वि॒तुर्वरे॑ण्यं॒ भर्गो॑ दे॒वस्य॑ धीमहि ।
धियो॒ यो नः॑ प्रचो॒दया॑त् ॥ १० ॥

> *tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ bhargo devasya dhīmahi |*
> *dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तत् । सवितुः । वरेण्यं । भर्गः । देवस्य । धीमहि ।
> धियः । यः । नः । प्रचोदयात् ॥ १० ॥

> *tat | savituḥ | vareṇyaṃ | bhargaḥ | devasya | dhīmahi |*
> *dhiyaḥ | yaḥ | naḥ | pracodayāt ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> दशरात्रस्य षष्ठेऽहनि वैश्वदेवशस्त्रे तत्सवितुरिति द्वे ऋचौ प्रतिपत्तृचस्य द्वितीयातृतीये । सूत्रितं च । तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे दोषो आगात् । आ. ८–१ । इति ॥ अभिप्लवपृष्ठ्यषडहयोर्द्वितीयेऽहनि वैस्वदेवशस्त्रे प्रतिपत्तृचस्यैते एव प्रथमाद्वितीये । सूत्रितं च । तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे आविश्वदेवं । आ. ७–६ । इति ॥
> यः सविता देवो नोऽस्माकं धियः कर्माणि धर्मादिविषया वा बुद्धीः प्रचोदयात् प्रेरयेत् तत्तस्य देवस्य सवितुः सर्वांतर्यामितया प्रेरकस्य जगत्स्रष्टुः परमेश्वरस्य वरेण्यं सर्वैरुपास्यतया ज्ञेयतया च संभजनीयं भर्गोऽविद्यातत्कार्ययोर्भर्जनाद्भर्गः स्वयंज्योतिः परब्रह्मात्मकं तेजो

> धीमहि । वयं ध्यायामः । यद्वा । तदिति भर्गोविशेषणं । सवितुर्देवस्य तत्तादृशं भर्गो धीमहि ।
> किं तदित्यपेक्षायामाह । य इति लिंगव्यत्ययः । यद्भर्गो
> धियः प्रचोदयात् । तद्धायेमेति समन्वयः । यद्वा । यः सविता सूरो
> धियः कर्माणि प्रचोदयात् प्रेरयति तस्य सवितुः सर्वस्य प्रसवितुर्देवस्य द्योत–

> *daśarātrasya ṣaṣṭhe 'hani vaiśvadevaśastre tatsavituriti dve ṛcau pratipattṛcasya*
> *dvitīyātṛtīye | sūtritaṃ ca | tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve doṣo āgāt | ā. 8-1 |*
> *iti ‖ abhiplavapṛṣṭhyaṣaḍahayordvitīye 'hani vaisvadevaśastre pratipattṛcasyaite eva*
> *prathamādvitīye | sūtritaṃ ca | tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve āviśvadevaṃ | ā. 7-6 | iti ‖*
> *yaḥ savitā devo no 'smākaṃ dhiyaḥ karmāṇi dharmādiviṣayā vā buddīḥ*
> *pracodayāt prerayet tattasya devasya savituḥ sarvāṃtaryāmitayā prerakasya*
> *jagatsaṣṭuḥ parameśvarasya vareṇyaṃ sarvairupāsyatayā jñeyatayā ca saṃbhajanīyaṃ*
> *bhargo 'vidyātatkāryayorbhajanādbhargaḥ svayaṃjyotiḥ parabrahmātmakaṃ tejo*
> *dhīmahi | vayaṃ dhyāyāmaḥ | yadvā | taditi bhargoviśeṣaṇaṃ |*
> *saviturdevasya tattādṛśaṃ bhargo dhīmahi | kiṃ tadityapekṣāyāmāha |*
> *ya iti liṃgavyatyayaḥ | yadbhargo*
> *dhiyaḥ pracodayāt | taddhāyemeti samanvayaḥ | yadvā | yaḥ savitā sūro*
> *dhiyaḥ karmāṇi pracodayāt prerayati tasya savituḥ sarvasya prasaviturdevasya dyota-*

> मानस्य सूरस्य तत्सर्वद्र्दृश्यमानतेया प्रसिद्धं वरेण्यं सर्वैः संभजनीयं भर्गः
> पापानां तापकं तेजोमंडलं धीमहि । धैयतया मनसा धारयेम । यद्वा ।
> भर्गःशब्देनान्नमभिधीयते । यः सविता देवो धियः प्रचोदयति तस्य प्रसादाद्भर्गोऽन्नादिलक्षणं
> फलं धीमहि । धारयामः । तस्याधारभूता भवेमेत्यर्थः ।
> भर्गःशब्द स्यान्नपरत्वे धीशब्दस्य कर्मपरत्वे चाथर्वणं । वेदांश्चंदांसि सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गो देवस्य
> कवयोऽन्नमाहुः कर्माणि धियस्तदु ते प्रब्रवीमि प्रचोदयंत्सविता याभिरेतीति । गो. ब्रा.
> १–३२ ॥ भर्गः । भ्रष्ट पाके । असुन् । भ्रस्टो
> रोपधयो रमन्यतरस्यां । पा. ६–४–४७ । इति रोपधयोर्लोपो रमागमः ।
> न्यंक्वादिपाठात् कुत्वं । धीमहि । ध्यायतेर्लिजि बहुलं छंदसीति संप्रसारणं ।

> व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । यद्वा । धीज् आधारे । लिजि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य
> लुक् । प्रचोदयात् । चोदयतेर्लेट्याडागमः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ।
> आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वे णिचः स्वरः ॥

> *mānasya sūrasya tatsarvadrdṛśyamānatèyā prasiddhaṃ vareṇyaṃ*
> *sarvaiḥ saṃbhajanīyaṃ bhargaḥ*
> *pāpānāṃ tāpakaṃ tejomaṃḍalaṃ dhīmahi | dhaiyatayā manasā*
> *dhārayema | yadvā |*
> *bhargaḥśabdenānnamabhidhīyate | yaḥ savitā devo dhiyaḥ pracodayati*
> *tasya prasādādbhargo 'nnādilakṣaṇaṃ phalaṃ dhīmahi | dhārayāmaḥ |*
> *tasyādhārabhūtā bhavemetyarthaḥ |*
> *bhargaḥśabda syānnaparatve dhīśabdasya karmaparatve cātharvaṇaṃ |*
> *vedāṃścaṃdāṃsi saviturvareṇyaṃ bhargò devasya kavayo 'nnamāhuḥ*
> *karmāṇi dhiyastadu te prabravīmi pracodayaṃtsavitā yābhiretīti | go.*
> *brā. 1-32 ‖ bhargaḥ | bhraṣṭa pāke | asun | bhrasṭo*
> *ropadhayo ramanyatarasyāṃ | pā. 6-4-47 | iti ropadhayorlopo*
> *ramāgamaḥ |*
> *nyaṃkvādipāṭhāt kutvaṃ | dhīmahi | dhyāyaterliji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti*
> *saṃprasāraṇaṃ |*
> *vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | yadvā | dhīj ādhāre | liji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti*
> *vikaraṇasya*
> *luk | pracodayāt | codayaterleṭyāḍāgamaḥ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *āgamasyānudāttatve ṇicaḥ svaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Use: on the sixth day of the Daśarātra, in the Vaiśvadeva-śastra, the two ṛks beginning तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*) are the second and third ṛks of the Pratipat tṛca. It is laid down in the sūtra तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे दोषो आगात् (*tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve doṣo āgāt*) (Ā. Sū. 8-1). On the second day of the Abhiplava and Pṛṣṭhya ṣaḍahas, in the Vaiśvadeva-śastra, these same two are the first and second ṛks of the Pratipat tṛca. It is laid down: तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे आविश्वदेवं (*tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve āviśvadevaṃ*) (Ā. Sū. 7-6).

Meaning: the god Savitṛ who may impel (प्रचोदयात् (*pracodayāt*)) our धियः (*dhiyaḥ*), our rites, or our thoughts concerned with dharma and the like: of that god Savitṛ, the impeller as inner controller of all, the creator of the world, Parameśvara, we meditate on the वरेण्यं

(*vareṇyaṃ*), which is to be resorted to by all as the object of worship and of knowledge, the भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*). It is called bhargas because it consumes (bhajana) ignorance and its effects; it is self-luminous light, of the nature of the Supreme Brahman. धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) means "we meditate".

Or else: तत् (*tat*) is an adjective of भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*): of the god Savitṛ we meditate on that bhargas of such a kind. If it is asked "what is that?", he answers: यः (*yaḥ*) here is a change of gender; the bhargas which may impel our thoughts; the construction is "may we meditate on that". Or else: the Savitṛ who is the sun impels धियः (*dhiyaḥ*), rites; of that Savitṛ, the god who gives birth to all, the shining sun (the sentence continues on the next page)

(continuing) … of that sun, the visible, universally known, desirable bhargas, the orb of light that burns up sins, we hold in the mind as the object of meditation.

Or else: the word भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*) denotes food. Through the grace of the god Savitṛ who impels thoughts, we take up (धीमहि (*dhīmahi*), we hold) the fruit characterised by food and the like; that is, may we become its support. For भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*) in the sense of food and धी (*dhī*) in the sense of rites, the Atharvaṇa text is cited: वेदांश्चंदांसि सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गो॑ देवस्य कवयोऽन्नमाहुः कर्माणि धियस्तदु ते प्रब्रवीमि प्रचोदयंत्सविता याभिरेतीति । (*vedāṃścaṃdāṃsi saviturvareṇyaṃ bhargò devasya kavayo 'nnamāhuḥ karmāṇi dhiyastadu te prabravīmi pracodayaṃtsavitā yābhiretīti* |) (Go. Brā. 1-32)[?249].

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—who
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- धियः (*dhiyaḥ*)—the intelligence concerned with rites
- प्रचोदयात् (*pracodayāt*)—impels
- तत् (*tat*)—such
- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of the god, of divine nature
- सवितुः (*savituḥ*)—of Savitṛ
- वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*)—to be worshipped by all

- भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*)—the light
- धीमहि (*dhīmahi*)—we meditate on

Gist

We meditate on the light, worshipped by the whole world, of such a Savitṛ, the god of divine nature, who impels in us the intelligence concerned with rites.

English translation

We meditate on that desirable light of the divine Savitri, who influences our pious rites.

Special Topics

On the sixth day of the sacrifice called Daśarātra, while the Vaiśvadeva-śastra mantras are recited, this ṛk तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*) and the next ṛk देवस्य सवितुः (*devasya savituḥ*) are to be recited as the second and third ṛks of the Pratipat tṛca (a tṛca is a group of three ṛks). This is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे दोषो आगात् (*tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve doṣo āgāt*) (Ā. 8-1).

And on the second day of the sacrifices called Abhiplava, Pṛṣṭhya and Ṣaḍaha, while the Vaiśvadeva-śastra mantras are recited, these two ṛks are to be recited as the first and second ṛks of the Pratipat tṛca. This is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमिति द्वे आ विश्वदेवं (*tatsaviturvareṇyamiti dve ā viśvadevaṃ*) (Ā. 7-6).

1. Sāyaṇa's explanation of the purport of the mantra तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*).

Sāyaṇa has shown that two kinds of meaning are possible for the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*) in this ṛk, and in accordance with it he has also explained the word भर्ग (*bharga*).

First, सवितृ (*savitṛ*) means Parameśvara, the inner controller of all, the impeller of the world, the creator of the world. The meaning of the word भर्ग (*bharga*) is the radiance that is of the nature of the Supreme Brahman. Because it destroys ignorance and the evil deeds that result from it, this radiance is well known by the apt name भर्ग (*bharga*). Because it is to be worshipped and revered by all, it has the adjective वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*). The word धी (*dhī*) means intellect. The purport is: let us meditate on this radiance, of the nature of the Supreme Brahman, which destroys ignorance, and may Savitṛ impel us to meditate in that way.

Second, सवितृ (*savitṛ*) means the sun, famous in the world. The word धी (*dhī*) means rites in worship of the sun. भर्ग (*bharga*) means the orb of light of Āditya, which destroys sin. The prayer is: may Savitṛ, the sun, impel us, who meditate on such an orb of light, to be devoted to rites.

Further, if on the authority of the Brāhmaṇa sentence वेदाश्चंदांसि तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गोदेवस्य कवयोऽन्नमाहुः (*vedāścaṃdāṃsi tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ bhargò devasya kavayo 'nnamāhuḥ*) (Go. Brā. 1-3-2)[?250] the word भर्ग (*bharga*) is taken to mean food, the purport becomes: by the grace of that Savitṛ who impels our intellect to be devoted to good rites, let us obtain fruit in the form of food and the like. If the meaning of the word *sava�tṛ* is shown to differ in this way, does the doctrine (tattva) then differ? Is a difference in the nature of the deity worshipped being stated? Do the words सवितृ (*savitṛ*), सूर (*sūra*), आदित्य (*āditya*), परब्रह्म (*parabrahma*) show different forms of one and the same principle, or do they show differences of principle as well? Such an inquiry is quite necessary in the present context.

1. Since the deity Savitṛ conveys the principle, the Gāyatrī is what the word सावित्रि (*sāvitri*) denotes.

तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं (*tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ*) is the great Gāyatrī mantra, famous in the world. It has Savitṛ as its deity; for that very reason it is also well known by the name सावित्रि (*sāvitri*). The Upaniṣad mantra गायत्रि मेव सावित्रीमनुब्रूयात् (*gāyatri meva sāvitrīmanubrūyāt*) teaches this identity (Bṛ. U. 5-14-5). The word सवितृ (*savitṛ*) means the Supreme Brahman; that the Supreme Brahman is the deity worshipped in this mantra is the (sentence continues on the next page) purport of the Upaniṣads. But since there is also room for objections, such as the pūrvapakṣa छंदोऽभिधानान्न (*chaṃdo 'bhidhānānna*) (Bra. Sū. 1-1-25), which state a meaning contrary to this purport and deny that the Supreme Brahman is the deity worshipped in this mantra, the meaning of this mantra must be examined thoroughly and its profound purport found out. This determination of the purport rests on the meaning of the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*).

1. The nature of Savitṛ as expressing the one principle.

It is the view of some among modern scholars that words such as सूर (*sūra*), सवितृ (*savitṛ*), आदित्य (*āditya*) show, in the Ṛk-saṃhitā, the diversity and the distinct kinds of deities.

"Savitri is comparatively a younger member of the Vedic Pantheon; this fact is simply corroborated by the very name of that God. The genesis of सवितृ (*savitṛ*) indicates cleanly a very last phase in the evolution of Vedic religious thought. The earlier and more important Gods of the Rig-Veda like वरुण (*varuṇa*), मित्र (*mitra*) and इंद्र (*iṃdra*) are mainly the personification of natural phenomena."

In this and similar ways Western scholars such as Oldenberg have expressed their opinion. The meaning is that deities such as Varuṇa, Indra and Mitra are ancient and Savitṛ is a more recent deity. That is, the conception of Savitṛ as a deity came to the ṛṣis who composed the Ṛk-saṃhitā only after a long time; the conception of this deity did not exist at first. The purport is that, having grasped the profundity of the variety of creation, they afterwards developed the conception of a special deity named Savitṛ in order to reflect that principle. Their view is that in this way a difference of name indicates a difference of deity. But careful examination shows that this is not quite the right opinion.

एक एनाग्निर्बहुधा समिद्ध एकः सूरो विश्वमनु प्रभूतः । एकैवोषाः सर्वमिदं वि भात्येकं वा इदं वि बभूव सर्वं ॥ (*eka enāgnirbahudhā samiddha ekaḥ sūro viśvamanu prabhūtaḥ | ekaivoṣāḥ sarvamidaṃ vi bhātyekaṃ vā idaṃ vi babhūva sarvaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-58-2).

As this mantra states clearly, the idea that one principle, which impels and nourishes all the affairs of the universe, pervades the universe is indicated, clearly and subtly, in many places in the Ṛk-saṃhitā.

यद्यद्विभूतिमत्सत्त्वं श्रीमदूर्जितमेव वा । तत्तदेवावगच्छ त्वं मम तेजोऽंशसंभवं ॥ (*yadyadvibhūtimatsattvaṃ śrīmadūrjitameva vā | tattadevāvagaccha tvaṃ mama tejo 'ṃśasaṃbhavaṃ* ‖) (Bha. Gī. 10-41)[?251]

Just as is said in this sentence of the Gītā, the Nirukta authors too have thus stated the nature of the groups of deities described in Vedic literature, and the highest principle that is the source of all deities:

महाभाग्याद्देवताया एक आत्मा बहुधा स्तूयते । .... एकस्य आत्मनः अन्ये देवाः प्रत्यंगानि भवंति ॥ (*mahābhāgyāddevatāyā eka ātmā bahudhā stūyate | .... ekasya ātmanaḥ anye devāḥ pratyaṃgāni bhavaṃti* ‖) (Ni. 7-4).

The principle that is the source of all deities is one only. But the infinite qualities of that principle are manifested in infinite forms, and all the diversities are only distinctions of the manifold glory of this principle. The Vedic sentence एकं सद्विप्रा बहुधा वदंति (*ekaṃ sadviprā bahudhā vadaṃti*) (1-164-46) also conveys this same point. तत्तत् स्थानविभागेन तत्र तत्रेह दृश्यते (*tattat sthānavibhāgena tatra tatreha dṛśyate*) (Bṛ. De. 1-70): the place and the nature of the action of each indicate the quality of that deity, but the original principle is one.

यो नः पिता जनिता यो विधाता धामानि वेद भुवनानि विश्वा । यो देवानां नामधा एक एव तं संप्रश्नं भुवना यंत्यन्या ॥ (*yo naḥ pitā janitā yo vidhātā dhāmāni veda bhuvanāni viśvā | yo devānāṃ nāmadhā eka eva taṃ saṃpraśnaṃ bhuvanā yaṃtyanyā* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-82-3).

Viśvakarman alone, the producer of the whole world, created the many kinds of deities such as Indra and pervaded the whole universe. Because he is the producer of everything, he has also obtained the name Savitṛ. And Prajāpati, the creator, is described as Savitṛ and as Tvaṣṭṛ:

देवस्त्वष्टा सविता विश्वरूपः पुपोष प्रजाः पुरुधा जजान । इमा च विश्वा भुवनान्यस्य महद्देवानामसुरत्वमेकं ॥ (*devastvaṣṭā savitā viśvarūpaḥ pupoṣa prajāḥ purudhā jajāna | imā ca viśvā bhuvanānyasya mahaddevānāmasuratvamekaṃ* ‖) (Mu. Saṃ. 3-55 - C.F)[?252]

गर्भे नु नौ जनिता दंपती कर्देवस्त्वष्टा सविता विश्वरूपः । नकिरस्य प्र मिनंति व्रतानि वेद नावस्य पृथिवी उत द्यौः ॥ (*garbhe nu nau janitā daṃpatī kardevastvaṣṭā savitā viśvarūpaḥ | nakirasya pra minaṃti vratāni veda nāvasya pṛthivī uta dyauḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-10-5).

In all such places Prajāpati, the creator and impeller of the world, is described as showing variety through difference of name and difference of action, while being originally the one principle of all. Therefore the opinion that a separate deity named Savitṛ, of a form different from deities such as Sūra, Āditya, Agni and Indra, exists and is described in embodied form is mistaken. Creation of the world, impelling the world's affairs, regulating those affairs, and all such activities are related to Savitṛ. To establish that this Savitṛ is Āditya, the Supreme Person within Āditya, the Vedic sentences that are the basis of this conclusion have to be examined carefully.

सविता सर्वस्य प्रसविता (*savitā sarvasya prasavitā*) (Ni. 10-31): because he is the producer of everything, the name is Savitṛ. Having shown this etymology of the word, the Nirukta authors cite

सविता यंत्रैः पृथिवीमरम्णादस्कंभने सविता द्यामदृंहत् । अश्वमिवाधुक्षद्धुनिमंतरिक्षमतूर्ते बद्धं सविता समुद्रं ॥ (*savitā yaṃtrṛḥ pṛthivīmaramṇādaskaṃbhane savitā dyāmadyaṃhat | aśvaminādhukṣaddunimaṃtarikṣamatūrte baddhaṃ savitā samudraṃ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-149-1).

Savitṛ has made the earth supported; he has made the unsupported atmosphere stand firm; and he has made the cloud that spreads over the sky pour rain. Having thus described Savitṛ's greatness, they ask कं अन्यं मध्यमात् एवं अवक्षत् (*kaṃ anyaṃ madhyamāt evaṃ avakṣat*): leaving aside the deity of the atmosphere, what other deity would the ṛṣi praise in this way? In answer, they state that आदित्योऽपि सवितोच्यते (*āditya 'pi savitocyate*), that Savitṛ is also a synonymous name of Āditya. They cite the ṛk

हिरण्यस्तूपः सवितर्यथा त्वांगिरसो जुह्वे वाजे अस्मिन् । एवा त्वार्चन्नवसे वंदमानः सोमस्येवांशुं प्रति जागराहं ॥ (*hiraṇyastūpaḥ savitaryathā tvāṃgiraso juhve vāje asmin | evā tvārcannavase vaṃdamānaḥ somasyevāṃśuṃ prati jāgarāhaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-19-5),

show that Āditya has the epithet Savitṛ, and indicate that the words आदित्य (*āditya*) and सवितृ (*savitṛ*) are synonymous names.

1. Description of the divine nature of Savitṛ, the controller of the universe, with the etymology of the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*).

The root सू (*sū*), from which the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*) comes, has different senses: 1) *ṣū* in the sense of impelling; 2) *ṣūṅ* in the sense of release of the young from the womb. Words formed from this root are used in the senses of "create", "impel" and "pour out" (oblations and the like). Sāyaṇa has explained the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*) in all these senses as suits each context. By explaining these meanings he has shown that Savitṛ alone is the controller of the whole world. That Savitṛ is the lord of creation, maintenance and the regulations is evident from the Ṛk-saṃhitā's own descriptions.

तत्सविता वोऽमृतत्वमासुवदगोह्यं यच्छ्रवयंत ऐतन । त्यं चिच्चमसमसुरस्य भक्षणमेकं संतमकृणुता चतुर्वयं ॥ (*tatsavitā vo 'mṛtatvamāsuvadagohyaṃ yacchravayaṃta aitana | tyaṃ ciccamasamasurasya bhakṣaṇamekaṃ saṃtamakṛṇutā caturvayaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-3).

In the Ṛk (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-110-3) quoted above, the deed of the Ṛbhus, who by Savitṛ's favour made the single cup (camasa) into four, must be taken as relating to the first creation of the world. Turning a state that is immortal and endless into a mortal form, and so making it finite, is the work of creation. This work of making things limited (bounded) belongs to the deity Savitṛ (or Sūra), the controller of the order of the seasons.

In all the passages यः पार्थिवानि विममे स एतशो रजांसि देवः सविता महित्वना । (*yaḥ pārthivāni vimame sa etaśo rajāṃsi devaḥ savitā mahitvanā* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-3) and मानेनेव तस्थिना अंतरिक्षे वि यो ममे पृथिवीं सूरेयण । (*māneneva tasthinā aṃtarikṣe vi yo mame pṛthivīṃ sūreyaṇa* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-85-5), the use of the root मा (*mā*) with the prefix वि (*vi*) indicates the controlling work of Savitṛ who is of the form of the sun, and of the sun who is of the form of Savitṛ. It was Savitṛ's work to bring the three worlds, which were formless, into a formed shape. As in the Ṛk 1-110-3 quoted above, so in the Atharva-saṃhitā too there is the description चमस यस्मिन् यशो निहितं विश्वरूपं (*camasa yasmin yaśo nihitaṃ viśvarūpaṃ*) (A. Ve. 10-8-9)[?253]. This description is the very one stated in the Īśāvāsyopaniṣad: हिरण्मयेन पात्रेण सत्यस्यापिहितं मुखं (*hiraṇmayena pātreṇa satyasyāpihitaṃ mukhaṃ*) (Īśa. 15)[?254]. The word पूष (*pūṣa*) addressed in this mantra of the Īśāvāsya means Sūra (the sun). The prayer here is: "Be the one who opens the face of the true Brahman of the solar orb, hidden by the golden vessel." The Ṛk-saṃhitā describes that the Ṛbhus made the truth, which was covered, imperceptible and beyond the senses, and which in its oneness was formless, into a formed thing, and produced variety so that it might become perceptible to the world. [That in Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-161-11 the word ऋभु (*ṛbhu*) was explained as the sun's rays and the word अगोह्य (*agohya*) as the sun has been stated earlier, in the special topics of that Ṛk.] The Ṛbhus too, the pupils of Savitṛ who is of the form of the sun (Ai. Brā. 3-30), are the sun's rays. But then everything would be included in the sun alone.

This is like Savitṛ's lordship described in sentences such as वनानि विभ्यो नकिरस्य तानि व्रता देवस्य सवितुर्मिनंति। (*vanāni vibhyo nakirasya tāni vratā devasya saviturminaṃti|*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-38-7) and यस्येंद्रो वरुणो (*yasyeṃdro varuṇo*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-38-9). The lordship of Indra and others is also described by sentences such as एको विश्वस्यभुवनस्य राजा (*eko viśvasyabhuvanasya rājā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-46-2). Since such descriptions occur for every deity,

another question arises: what then is Savitṛ's distinction? In answer, some have expressed the opinion that such a description is only figurative and holds no distinction; Savitṛ, like the other deities, is one of the lesser particular deities. To know Savitṛ's distinction, the nivid mantra relating to Savitṛ must be recited. For example:

न प्रमिये सवितुर्दैव्यस्य तद्यथा विश्वं भुवनं धारयिष्यति । यत्पृथिव्या वरिमन्ना स्वंगुरिर्वर्षन्दिवः सुवति सत्यमस्य तत् ॥ (*na pramiye saviturdaivyasya tadyathā viśvaṃ bhuvanaṃ dhārayiṣyati | yatpṛthivyā varimannā svaṃgurirvarṣandivaḥ suvati satyamasya tat ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-55-4)

In mantras of this kind Savitṛ's chief quality is described. Here activities such as the regulation of the universe and the protection of truth are indicated. In the same way,

1. Varuṇa too, the overseer of Ṛta, is nothing but a particular manifestation of Savitṛ's glory.

In passages such as त्रिपंचाशः क्रीळति व्रात एषां देव इव सविता सत्यधर्मा (*tripaṃcāśaḥ krīḷati vrāta eṣāṃ deva iva savitā satyadharmā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-34-8), the protection of truth is shown to be Savitṛ's special quality. जगतः स्थातुरुभयस्य यो वशी (*jagataḥ sthāturubhayasya yo vaśī*) (4-53-6): Savitṛ is the master of the whole world, moving and unmoving. विश्वस्य हि श्रुष्टये .... रमते परिज्मन् (*viśvasya hi śruṣṭaye .... ramate parijman*) (2-38-2): whether subtle or gross, a thing moves only by his regulation. The Atharvaṇa describes the same in sentences such as देवस्य सवितुः सर्वे कर्म कृण्वंतु मानवाः । (*devasya savituḥ sarve karma kṛṇvaṃtu mānavāḥ |*) (A. Ve. 6-23-3). All this is like the description of the god Varuṇa, overseer of Ṛta. Therefore it must also be examined whether there is a difference between Savitṛ and Varuṇa; whether they are different deities, or two forms of one principle, or one thing described by different qualities.

If certain Saṃhitā sentences are examined, they appear to state the identity of Varuṇa and Savitṛ. For example, प्र त्वा मुंचामि वरुणस्य पाशाद्येन त्वाबध्नात् सविता सुशेवः । (*pra tvā muṃcāmi varuṇasya pāśādyena tvābadhnāt savitā suśevaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-85-24): here Varuṇa's noose and Savitṛ's noose are alike. In the commentary Sāyaṇa says that Varuṇa, impelled by Savitṛ, binds the born creatures with his noose. But releasing the person so bound is also Savitṛ's work, or must come about through his grace. That the protection of right conduct, the protection of truth and the regulation of the universe are a common property of Savitṛ and Varuṇa is clear in the passages 2-38-2; 3-33-6; 4-53-4; 10-34-8; 10-139-3 and others where Savitṛ is described, and in the Ṛks 6-70-1; 7-86-1; 8-41-10; 8-42-1 and others where Varuṇa is described. Because he upholds the order of the universe, Savitṛ is also addressed as Mitra: उत रात्रिमुभयतः परीयस उत मित्रो भवसि देव धर्मभिः (*uta rātrimubhayataḥ parīyasa uta mitro bhavasi deva dharmabhiḥ*) (5-81-4). The purport is that, being lord of the work of sustaining the world, Savitṛ is also famed by the name Mitra. As सर्वस्य प्रसविता (*sarvasya prasavitā*) (the impeller of all), the act of generation is not Savitṛ's work alone; he is also the cause of the world's continuance. बृहत्सुम्मः प्रसवीता निवेशनो जगतः (*bṛhatsummaḥ prasavītā niveśano jagataḥ*) and so on (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-53-6): thus Savitṛ's greatness is described.

Secondly, it is a noteworthy point that the very well known word असुर (*asura*), an epithet of Varuṇa, is also an epithet of Savitṛ. In passages such as तद्देवस्य सवितुर्वीर्यं महद्वृणीमहे असुरस्य प्रचेतसः (*taddevasya saviturvīryaṃ mahadvṛṇīmahe asurasya pracetasaḥ*) (4-57-1), Savitṛ's power is indicated in describing this special quality. That Savitṛ is praised in the same manner as Varuṇa, the destroyer of sin, shows the quality they share. For example:

अचित्ती यच्च कृमा दैव्ये जने दीनैर्दक्षैः प्रभूती पूरुषत्वता । देवेषु च सवितर्मानुषेषु च त्वं नो अत्र सुवतादनागसः ॥ (*acittī yacca kṛmā daivye jane dīnairdakṣaiḥ prabhūtī pūruṣatvatā | deveṣu ca savitarmānuṣeṣu ca tvaṃ no atra suvatādanāgasaḥ ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-54-3)

"O Savitṛ, if we have sinned through ignorance, through pride, through weakness, or through the weakness common to men, forgive it. If we have reviled a divine person or the gods, forgive it. May no harm come to us." This is a prayer like

यत्किं चेदं वरुण दैव्ये जनेभिद्रोहं मनुष्या ३ श्चरामसि । अचित्ती यत्तव धर्मा युयोपिम मा नस्तस्मादेनसो देव रीरिषः ॥ (*yatkiṃ cedaṃ varuṇa daivye janebhidrohaṃ manuṣyā 3 ścarāmasi | acittī yattava dharmā yuyopima mā nastasmādenaso deva rīriṣaḥ ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-89-5)

Here too the uniformity of the manner of prayer, the single style, is a noteworthy point. Looking at such passages one may say that Varuṇa and Savitṛ are one particular deity reflecting one principle. As the epithet सम्राट् (*samrāṭ*) belongs to Varuṇa, so in many places it indicates Savitṛ's lordship also.

1. Epithets showing the common nature of Savitṛ and Varuṇa

Two epithet words, अमति (*amati*) and माया (*māyā*), serve to show the unity of the two. Both are epithets denoting power and beauty. In the same manner in which the radiance of the golden Puruṣa within the sun is described, the power and beauty of Savitṛ and Varuṇa are described.

उदु ष्य देवः सविता ययाम हिरण्ययामवतिं यामशिश्रेत् । नूनं भगो हव्यो मानुषेभिर्वि यो रत्ना पुरूवसुर्दधाति ॥ (*udu ṣya devaḥ savitā yayāma hiraṇyayāmavatiṃ yāmaśiśret | nūnaṃ bhago havyo mānuṣebhirvi yo ratnā purūvasurdadhāti ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-38-1)

Here is the description of Savitṛ, who is of golden form; and

ऋतस्य बुध्न उषसामिषण्यन्वषा मही रोदसी आ विवेश । मही मित्रस्य वरुणस्य माया चंद्रेव भानुं वि दधे पुरुत्रा ॥ (*ṛtasya budhna uṣasāmiṣaṇyanvaṣā mahī rodasī ā viveśa | mahī mitrasya varuṇasya māyā caṃdreva bhānuṃ vi dadhe purutrā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-61-7)

here the description of Varuṇa's power of radiance; the two are alike. These two descriptions tell of the unearthly, supernatural radiance and divine power of one divine principle bearing the names Savitṛ and Varuṇa. As in the first example the word अमति (*amati*) is explained as divine radiance, so in the second too the word माया (*māyā*) is explained as divine radiance. As the word अमति (*amati*) has the epithet हिरण्ययीं (*hiraṇyayīṃ*), the word माया (*māyā*) has the simile चंद्रेव (*caṃdreva*). The nature of the two radiances is the same. In passages such as ऋतेन विश्वं भुवनं वि राजथः सूर्यामा धत्तो दिवि चित्रं रथं । (*ṛtena viśvaṃ bhuvanaṃ vi rājathaḥ sūryāmā dhatto divi citraṃ rathaṃ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-63-7) and विश्वा रूपाणि प्रति मुंचते कविः प्रासावीद्भद्रं द्विपदे चतुष्पदे । (*viśvā rūpāṇi prati muṃcate kaviḥ prāsāvīdbhadraṃ dvipade catuṣpade* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-2), the power is described of spreading their divine radiance over the whole world and making the entire universe attractive. The description of Varuṇa that explains this golden radiance, हिरण्यपक्षं वरुणस्य दूतं (*hiraṇyapakṣaṃ varuṇasya dūtaṃ*) (10-123-6), and the description of Savitṛ in हिरण्ययेन सविता रथेना देवो याति भुवनानि पश्यन् (*hiraṇyayena savitā rathenā devo yāti bhuvanāni paśyan*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-35-2) and the like, show the non-difference of the two. Moreover, as Savitṛ is established as being of the nature of the sun on the basis of Vedic sentences, there are clear proofs for saying that Varuṇa too is of the nature of the sun. In the Taittirīya-brāhmaṇa and other texts it is said नारुणो वा अश्वः (*nāruṇo vā aśvaḥ*) (Tai. Brā. 3-9-16-1)[?255]. As to the hidden meaning of this horse of Varuṇa, the scholar Eggling, when translating the Śatapatha-brāhmaṇa, said as follows.

"This horse of Varuṇa, the lord of heaven and earth, is none other than the sun, who undergoes his daily revolution."

By many such proofs it must be said that Varuṇa too is a special manifestation of the sun. This point was set out at length earlier when explaining the mantra sentence ऋतादध्यादधाथे अनृतं (*ṛtādadhyādadhāthe anṛtaṃ*) (1-139-2) and the mantra अनश्वो जातो अनभीशुरर्वा........अचित्तं ब्रह्म जुजुषुर्युवानः (*anaśvo jāto anabhīśurarvā........acittaṃ brahma jujuṣuryuvānaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-152-5). And in the passages cited here a spiritual principle is stated which joins the sacrificial act, whose principle is hidden and not visible to ordinary sight, with the luminous abode of Varuṇa.

1. The golden Puruṣa within the sun, who is of Savitṛ's nature.

Thus, if Savitṛ and Varuṇa are both special manifestations of the sun, the description of their golden form amounts to a statement of the sun's nature. The nature of the sun described in the Ṛk-saṃhitā by sentences such as हिरण्ययीं अमतिं (*hiraṇyayīṃ amatiṃ*), and the nature of the Supreme Puruṣa within the sun described in the Upaniṣads and other texts, are one and the same.

तस्य हैतस्य पुरुषस्य रूपं । यथा महारजनं वासः । यथा पांड्वाविकं, यथेंद्रगोपः, यथाग्न्यर्चिः, यथा पुंडरीकं । यथा सकृद्विद्युत्तं ॥ (*tasya haitasya puruṣasya rūpaṃ | yathā mahārajanaṃ vāsaḥ | yathā pāṃḍvāvikaṃ, yatheṃdragopaḥ, yathāgnyarciḥ, yathā puṃḍarīkaṃ | yathā sakṛdvidyuttaṃ ‖*) (Bṛ. U. 2-3-6)

The Bṛhadāraṇyaka's description is that the form of this Supreme Puruṣa shines like a cloth filled with saffron colour, like white silk, like the glow of the crimson indragopa insect, like a flame of fire, like a white lotus, like lightning.

य एषोऽंतरादित्ये हिरण्मयः पुरुषो दृश्यते हिरण्यश्मश्रुर्हिरण्यकेश आप्रणखात्सर्व एव सुवर्णः ॥ (*ya eṣo 'ṃtarāditye hiraṇmayaḥ puruṣo dṛśyate hiraṇyaśmaśrurhiraṇyakeśa āpraṇakhātsarva eva suvarṇaḥ ‖*) (Chā. U. 1-6-6)

All the beard of this golden Supreme Puruṣa within the sun is golden. The Chāndogya Upaniṣad's description, that from the nails of the feet to the head the form of this Puruṣa is exceedingly radiant and made attractive by divine light, is likewise equal to the description of Savitṛ's radiance quoted above. And this same sun in the Upaniṣads and other texts

is praised in two ways. That the sun carries on the work of the world by his rising and setting movements is perceptible to ordinary sight. But the sun described in sentences such as न वै तत्र न निम्मोच नोदियाय कदाचन (*na vai tatra na nimmoca nodiyāya kadācana*) (Chā. U. 3-11; 1-3) has no rising or setting. For him it is always eternal day. And सकृद्विभातो हैवैष ब्रह्मलोकः (*sakṛdvibhāto haivaiṣa brahmalokaḥ*) (Chā. U. 8-4-2): here is the praise of the radiance of the eternal, supernatural Supreme Puruṣa within the sun, to the effect that the radiance of this divine world is eternal. It is this solar principle that holds all moving and unmoving things in a regulated state. The praise of the sun to be recited at the daily rites after the utterance of the Gāyatrī mantra तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं (*tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ*) is well known:

चित्रं देवानामुदगादनीकं चक्षुर्मित्रस्य वरुणस्याग्नेः । आप्रा द्यावापृथिवी अंतरिक्षं सूर्य आत्मा जगतस्तस्थु षश्च ॥ (*citraṃ devānāmudagādanīkaṃ cakṣurmitrasya varuṇasyāgneḥ | āprā dyāvāpṛthivī aṃtarikṣaṃ sūrya ātmā jagatastasthu ṣaśca ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-15-1)

In this mantra both the sun's sphere of radiance, perceptible to ordinary sight, and the supernatural divine principle are praised. The radiant sun with his rays rises as the eye of Mitra and Varuṇa and pervades heaven and earth. The Supreme Self within this solar orb is like the self that brings unity to the whole world. He who is praised by sentences such as हिरण्यगर्भः समवर्तताग्रे भूतस्य जातः पतिरेक आसीत् ॥ स दाधार पृथिवीं द्यामुतेमां ॥ (*hiraṇyagarbhaḥ samavartatāgre bhūtasya jātaḥ patireka āsīt ‖ sa dādhāra pṛthivīṃ dyāmutemāṃ ‖*) (10-121-1) is likewise this same Supreme Self who is of Savitṛ's form. It is therefore proper to state a purport relating to the Supreme Self for the mantra in hand. The commentary written by Bhaṭṭabhāskara on the Taittirīya-saṃhitā for this mantra is as follows.

यो देवस्सविता विश्वस्य प्रसवितास्माकं धर्मादिगोचरा धियः प्रेरयति तस्य स्वभूतं वरेण्यं सर्वैर्भजनीयं भर्गः पापानां तापनं तेजोमंडलात्मकं धीमहि मनसा धारयामः ॥ एवं बोधप्रकाशाभ्यां समस्तस्य प्रपंचस्योपकुर्वाणं श्रेयोऽर्थिभिर्भजनीयं सूर्यात्मना स्थितं पारमेश्वरं तेजः उपास्यत्वेनोपदिश्यते ॥ (*yo devassavitā viśvasya prasavitāsmākaṃ dharmādigocarā dhiyaḥ prerayati tasya svabhūtaṃ vareṇyaṃ sarvairbhajanīyaṃ bhargaḥ pāpānāṃ tāpanaṃ tejomaṃḍalātmakaṃ dhīmahi manasā dhārayāmaḥ ‖ evaṃ bodhaprakāśābhyāṃ samastasya prapaṃcasyopakurvāṇaṃ śreyo 'rthibhirbhajanīyaṃ sūryātmanā sthitaṃ pārameśvaraṃ tejaḥ upāsyatvenopadiśyate ‖*) (Tai. Saṃ. Bhā. 1-5-6-6)

In this commentary, by बोधप्रकाशाभ्यां उपकुर्वाणं (*bodhaprakāśābhyāṃ upakurvāṇaṃ*) two benefits of the sun's radiance are shown: first, the physical light needed for worldly affairs; second, the inner light that helps spiritual knowledge, that is, divine knowledge. Both benefits are possible through Savitṛ's bhargas. The commentary of Mahīdharācārya on this same mantra in the Śukla-yajus-saṃhitā is as follows—

In this bhāṣya the words *bodhaprakāśābhyāṃ upakurvāṇaṃ* show two benefits of Āditya's radiance. The first is the physical light needed for worldly activity. The second is the inner light that helps spiritual knowledge, that is, divine knowledge. Both benefits are possible through the Bharga of Savitṛ. Mahīdhara Ācārya's commentary on this same mantra in the Śukla Yajus Saṃhitā runs as follows:

सवितुः प्रेरकस्यांतर्यामिणो विज्ञानानंदस्वभावस्य हिरण्यगर्भोपाध्यवच्छिन्नस्य वा आदित्यांतरपुरुषस्य वा ब्रह्मणः भर्गः पापानां भर्जनसमर्थं तेजः सत्यज्ञानानन्दादिवेदान प्रतिसाद्यं वयं ध्यायामः ॥ (*savituḥ prerakasyāṃtaryāmiṇo vijñānānaṃdasvabhāvasya hiraṇyagarbhopādhyavacchinnasya vā ādityāṃtarapuruṣasya vā brahmaṇaḥ bhargaḥ pāpānāṃ bharjanasamarthaṃ tejaḥ satyajñānānandādivedāna pratisādyaṃ vayaṃ dhyāyāmaḥ ‖*)

It is a prayer: "We meditate on the divine radiance of the Supreme Brahman. He is the inner controller in all beings and the impeller of the world. He is addressed by names such as Hiraṇyagarbha, and he dwells within Āditya. That radiance destroys sins and is taught by the Vedānta in forms such as truth, knowledge and bliss."

The radiance of Savitṛ of this kind is also well known under the names Sutejas and Sutatejas. The great radiance of which it is said

उद्वयं तमसस्परि ज्योतिष्पश्यंत उत्तरं । देवं देवत्रा सूर्यमगन्म ज्योतिरुत्तमं ॥ (*udvayaṃ tamasaspari jyotiṣpaśyaṃta uttaraṃ | devaṃ devatrā sūryamaganma jyotiruttamaṃ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 150-10)[?257]

and so on in the Ṛk Saṃhitā, and in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā:

अगन्न ज्योतिरुत्तममित्याहासौ वा आदित्यो ज्योतिरुत्तममादित्यस्यैव सायुज्यं गच्छति ॥ (*aganna jyotiruttamamityāhāsau vā āditya jyotiruttamamādityasyaiva sāyujyaṃ gacchati ‖*) Tai. Saṃ. 5-1-8-6.

This radiance of Āditya is the Supreme Light. One who has crossed the darkness of ignorance attains union with it. It is noteworthy that, as it is praised in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, the Upaniṣads describe it as Sutejas, Sutatejas and so on. In एष वै सुतेजा आत्मा तस्मात्तव सुतं, प्रसुतमासुतं कुले जन्म (*eṣa vai sutejā ātmā tasmāttava sutaṃ, prasutamāsutaṃ kule janma*) (Chā. 5-12-1)[?258], a relation of cause and effect is stated between the good radiance (sutejas) of Āditya and the constant pressing (suta) of Soma in the family that worships such a radiance. This point will be examined when the relation between Gāyatrī and Soma is explained. Here, the light that is praised in इदं श्रेष्ठं ज्योतिषां ज्योतिः (*idaṃ śreṣṭhaṃ jyotiṣāṃ jyotiḥ*) (1-113-1) and the like is, in the mantra under discussion, designated by the word Bharga. This Bharga is the light of the Supreme Brahman, which destroys ignorance.

(8) The Supreme Light of the Supreme Person is the Bharga of Savitṛ.

(Objection and reply)

When the Bharga of Savitṛ is thus established as the Supreme Light of the Supreme Person, another objection may be expected. Just as there is an attempt to place Savitṛ in the group of lesser deities, a view may state its opinion in the form of this objection: that this great radiance too is only physical light. For example, the Supreme Light described in the Ṛk Saṃhitā as सूरमगन्म ज्योतिरुत्तमं (*sūramaganma jyotiruttamaṃ*) is praised in the Upaniṣads and elsewhere as अध यदतः परो दिवो ज्योतिः (*adha yadataḥ paro divo jyotiḥ*) (Chā. U. 2-13-7). Is this only the physical light of the sun? Or is it the divine light of the divine Person who dwells within Āditya?

Where this doubt exists, the opponent says: "आदित्यादिकमेव ज्योतिश्येन परिगृह्यत इति (*ādityādikameva jyotiśyena parigṛhyata iti*) — we call this only the light of the sun, which is visible to the physical eye." (Bra. Sū., Śaṅkara-bhāṣya, 1-1-24).

किं तावत्पाप्तं ? आदित्यादिकमेव ज्योतिश्यब्देन परिगृह्यत इति । कुतः प्रसिद्धेः । तमो ज्योतिरिति हीमौ शब्दौ परस्परप्रतिद्वंद्विविषयौ प्रसिद्धौ.... नहि चराचरबीजस्य ब्रह्मणः सर्वात्मकस्य द्यौर्मर्यादा युक्ता ॥ (*kiṃ tāvatpāptaṃ ? ādityādikameva jyotiśyabdena parigṛhyata iti | kutaḥ prasiddheḥ | tamo jyotiriti hīmau śabdau parasparapratidvaṃdviviṣayau prasiddhau.... nahi carācarabījasya brahmaṇaḥ sarvātmakasya dyaurmaryādā yuktā ||*)

The words "darkness" and "light" are things perceived by the eye. And since the light belongs to the sky, it cannot be of the nature of the Supreme Brahman, which is endless and undivided. The sky is limited and not all-pervading. Therefore the light bounded by such a sky is also limited and, unlike the Supreme Brahman, not all-pervading. Hence, says the opponent, there is a difference between these lights and Brahman. The conclusion that answers this is:

नैष दोषः । सर्वत्रापि गम्यमानस्य ज्योतिषः परो दिवः इत्युपासनार्थः प्रदेशविशेषपरिग्रहो न विरुद्धते ॥ न तु निष्प्रदेशस्यापि ब्रह्मणः प्रदेशविशेषकल्पना भागिनी................ (*naiṣa doṣaḥ | sarvatrāpi gamyamānasya jyotiṣaḥ paro divaḥ ityupāsanārthaḥ pradeśaviśeṣaparigraho na viruddhate ‖ na tu niṣpradeśasyāpi brahmaṇaḥ pradeśaviśeṣakalpanā bhāginī...............*)

When the nature of the effect is being explained, it is not right to attribute identity with the principle of the cause and then to limit to a region the all-pervading Lord. As in passages such as तद्देवा ज्योतिषां ज्योतिरायुर्होपासतेऽमृतं (*taddevā jyotiṣāṃ jyotirāyurhopāsate 'mṛtaṃ*) (Bṛ. U. 4-4-16), it is argued from that context that the text points to the Supreme Light of the Supreme Person. From the commentator's explanation of the mantra beginning तत्त्ववितुः (*tattvavituḥ*) it is understood that this same purport applies here also to the Bharga of Savitṛ.

(9) To know the Bharga, which is the Supreme Light, the chief means is meditation in the form of reciting the Gāyatrī.

The prayer is: "Impel our intellect to realise directly, through meditation, the Supreme Light of Savitṛ, which lies beyond worldly perception." That is, the nature of the Supreme Light of the Supreme Brahman can be known only by meditation in the form of reciting the great Gāyatrī mantra. Śaṅkarācārya states this very matter in the introduction to the Gāyatrī section of the Chāndogya Upaniṣad:

गायत्रीद्वारेण चोच्यते ब्रह्म सर्वविशेषरहितस्य “ नेति नेति ” इत्यादि विशेषप्रतिषेधगम्यस्य दुर्बोधत्वात् । सत्त्वनेकेषु छंदस्सु गायत्रा एव ब्रह्मज्ञानतयोपादानं प्राधान्यात् । सोमाहरणादितरच्छंदोक्षरा- हरणेनेतरच्छंदोव्याप्त्या च सर्वसवनव्यापकत्वाच्च यज्ञे प्राधान्यं गायत्र्याः । गायत्रीसारत्वाच्च ब्राह्मणस्य मातरमिव । हित्वा गुरुतरां गायत्रीं ततोऽन्यद्गुरुतरं न प्रतिपद्यते यथोक्तं ब्रह्मापीति तस्यामत्यंतगौरवस्य प्रसिद्धत्वात् । अतो गायत्रीमुखेनैव ब्रहोच्यते ॥ (*gāyatrīdvāreṇa cocyate brahma sarvaviśeṣarahitasya “ neti neti ” ityādi viśeṣapratiṣedhagamyasya durbodhatvāt | sattvanekeṣu chaṃdassu gāyatrā eva brahmajñānatayopādānaṃ prādhānyāt | somāharaṇāditaracchaṃdokṣarā-haraṇenetaracchaṃdovyāptyā ca sarvasavanavyāpakatvācca yajñe prādhānyaṃ gāyatryāḥ | gāyatrīsāratvācca brāhmaṇasya mātaramiva | hitvā* *gurutarāṃ gāyatrīṃ tato 'nyadgurutaraṃ na pratipadyate yathoktaṃ brahmāpīti tasyāmatyaṃtagauravasya prasiddhatvāt | ato gāyatrīmukhenaiva brahocyate ||*)

Supreme Brahman is beyond perception by the eye and the like. He is not an object visible to the eye, nor can he be seen by the mind's vision, nor is he any object in the world of ordinary dealings. The Supreme Self can be described only in the negative form, in this way. Though there are many other metres, realisation of the Supreme Self is possible only with the help of the Gāyatrī. That the Gāyatrī has this power as a means is shown by the prominent part it plays in the sacrificial act. Because sacrifices and other rites help divine knowledge, and because the Gāyatrī's help is indispensable in carrying out such sacrifices, the Gāyatrī is also the most important means to the knowledge of Brahman. This prominence is understood from three points:

1. First, because the Gāyatrī brought to the gods the Soma that is central to the sacrifice;
2. second, because it has drawn into itself the syllables of the other metres and pervades them all;
3. third, because it pervades all three pressings (savana), the Gāyatrī has primacy in the sacrificial act.

Śaṅkarācārya makes clear that, because it is like a mother to Brāhmaṇas and the rest, and because the knowledge of the nature of Brahman also rests on the Gāyatrī, the Gāyatrī is the chief means for the direct realisation of the nature of the light of Brahman. What is the scriptural basis for each of these three points that Śaṅkarācārya states, and how is this primacy of the Gāyatrī described in the Śruti passages? This now has to be examined.

(10) Three points showing the primacy of the Gāyatrī.

1. The episode of the bringing of Soma. The effort of the Śyena bird.

First: सोमाहरणात् (*somāharaṇāt*), "because it brought the Soma that is central to the sacrifice". Thus the special power of the Gāyatrī is indicated. This episode of the bringing of Soma is described in all the most important places in the Saṃhitās and the Brāhmaṇas. First of all,

it is told as a story in the Ṛk Saṃhitā itself. In Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26 and 4-27, when Indra describes his own valour, he tells how that valour grew through drinking Soma, and how the Gāyatrī brought that Soma.

[Whether this description is the speech of the seer Vāmadeva or of Indra, and whether the deity of these sūktas is Indra or the Supreme Self, are also matters to note. That discussion is unnecessary here.

प्र सु ष विभ्यो मरुतो विरस्तु प्र श्येनः श्येनेभ्य अशुपत्वा । अचक्रया यत्स्वधया सुपर्णो हव्यं भरन्मनवे देवजुष्टं ॥ (*pra su ṣa vibhyo maruto virastu pra śyenaḥ śyenebhya aśupatvā | acakrayā yatsvadhayā suparṇo havyaṃ bharanmanave devajuṣṭaṃ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26-4)

O Maruts, may this Suparṇa, who brought this Soma desired by the gods to Manu in a chariot without a wheel, swiftly, be greater in vigour than the other Śyena birds, and may he receive greater honour.

भरद्यदि विरतो वेविजानः पथोरुणा मनोजना असर्जि । तोयं ययौ मधुना सोम्येगोत श्रवो विविदे श्येनो अत्र ॥ (*bharadyadi virato vevijānaḥ pathoruṇā manojanā asarji | tòyaṃ yayau madhunā somyegota śravo vivide śyeno atra ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26-5)

This Śyena bird rebuked the guardians of the Soma, carried off the Soma, and glided down through the sky at the speed of thought and helped; therefore honour on earth came to the whole company of Śyena birds.

ऋजीषी श्येनो ददमानो अंशुं परावतः शकुनो मंद्रं मदं । सोमं भरद्दादृहाणो देवानान्दिवो अमुष्मादुत्तरादादाय ॥ (*ṛjīṣī śyeno dadamāno aṃśuṃ parāvataḥ śakuno maṃdraṃ madaṃ | somaṃ bharaddādṛhāṇo devānāndivo amuṣmāduttarādādāya ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26-6)

This bird, flying straight through the sky at the speed of thought and followed by the gods, brought the Soma and with it increased resolve and faith. By bringing the Soma it did good to the world.

आदाय श्येनो आभरत्सोमं सहस्रं सना आयुतं च साकं । अत्रा पुरंधिरजहादरातीर्मदे सोमस्य मूरा अमूरः ॥ (*ādāya śyeno ābharatsomaṃ sahasraṃ sanā āyutaṃ ca sākaṃ | atrā puraṃdhirajahādarātīrmade somasya mūrā amūraḥ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26-7)

The Śyena bird brought the Soma from the heavenly world and helped in carrying out thousands of sacrifices. Indra, satisfied by drinking this Soma, grew in valour and crushed all his enemies.

अव यच्छेनो अस्वनीदथ द्योर्वि यद्यदि वात ऊहुः पुरंधिं । सृजद्यदस्मा अव ह क्षिपज्ज्यां कृशानुरस्ता मनसा भुरण्यन् ॥ (*ava yaccheno asvanīdatha dyorvi yadyadi vāta ūhuḥ puraṃdhiṃ | sṛjadyadasmā ava ha kṣipajjyāṃ kṛśānurastā manasā bhuraṇyan ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-27-3)

After bringing the Soma, as the Śyena was coming down from the sky expressing its joy, Kṛśānu, one of the Soma-guardians and an archer, also came down at the speed of thought, chased it, and shot an arrow at it from his bow.

यजिष्य ईमिंद्रावतो न भुज्युं श्येनो जभार बृहतो अधि ष्ठोः । अंतः पतत्पतत्र्यस्य पर्णमध यामनि प्रसितस्य तद्वेः ॥ (*yajiṣya īmiṃdrāvato na bhujyuṃ śyeno jabhāra bṛhato adhi ṣṭhoḥ | aṃtaḥ patatpatatryasya parṇamadha yāmani prasitasya tadveḥ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-27-4)

As this Śyena was coming down from the sky that lies under Indra's lordship, it was struck by Kṛśānu's arrow, and in its struggle it lost a feather from its body and was wounded.

While the story is of this kind, finding what principle lies here costs effort. Even so, introducing the seer of this sūkta, Nāmadeva[?259], the Aitareya Āraṇyaka explains this same occasion from the standpoint of principle. There, quoting the Ṛk of the Ṛk Saṃhitā

गर्भे नु सन्नन्वेषामवेदमहं देवानां जनिमानि विश्वा । शतं मा पुर आयसीररक्षन्नध श्येनो जवसा निरदीयं ॥ (*garbhe nu sannanveṣāmavedamahaṃ devānāṃ janimāni viśvā | śataṃ mā pura āyasīrarakṣannadha śyeno javasā niradīyaṃ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-26-1)

it says गर्भ एव एतच्छयानो वामदेव एवमुवाच (*garbha eva etacchayāno vāmadeva evamuvāca*) (Ai. Ā. 2-5). It says that Vāmadeva, while still lying in the womb, knew this principle and spoke it. The meaning of the above mantra is that the origins and natures of all the gods were revealed to Vāmadeva while he was in the womb, and that, although there was a bondage made of hundreds of iron bars, he slipped out of it like a Śyena bird and flew towards the earth. The purport of this passage is not easy. Śaṅkarācārya, Ānandatīrtha and Sāyaṇa, when they explain this occasion, take the purport to be that Vāmadeva entered hundreds of bodies as bonds, finally became a knower, was freed from them and attained liberation. But if the context of the Aitareya Āraṇyaka is examined, स एवं विद्वान् आस्माच्छरीरभेदादूर्ध्व उत्क्रम्यामुष्मिन् स्वर्गे लोके सर्वान्नामानाप्तामृतः समभवत्समभवत् । (*sa evaṃ vidvān āsmāccharīrabhedādūrdhva utkramyāmuṣmin svarge loke sarvānnāmānāptāmṛtaḥ samabhavatsamabhavat* |) (Ai. Ā. 2-5): it says that Vāmadeva, who knew this principle while in the womb, gave up the earthly body and attained liberation. It is therefore understood that the words of Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-27-1 apply to Vāmadeva himself[?260]. Moreover, on the basis of the statement that in mantras such as 1-32-14 and 10-99-8 Indra is described as like the Śyena bird, some scholars hold that the mantra beginning "Garbhe nu ...." (printed with abridgement dots)

refers to Indra himself. But that is wrong. Some others have said that it is the speech of Soma (Ludwig).

2. The Gāyatrī in the form of a bird is the Śyena.

Sāyaṇa alone, however, says in

श्येनभावं समास्थाय गर्भाद्योगेन निस्सृतः । ऋषिगर्भे शयानःसन् ब्रूते गर्भे नु सन्निति ॥ (*śyenabhāvaṃ samāsthāya garbhādyogena nissṛtaḥ | ṛṣigarbhe śayānaḥsan brūte garbhe nu sanniti ‖*)

(introduction to the bhāṣya on 4-27-1)

that Vāmadeva himself, freed from the womb by the greatness of his yoga, utters this sentence. None of the English critics such as Ludwig has examined the reason and the basis for the Śyena being described in the form of the Gāyatrī. In describing this same occasion, the Śyena is called by the word Suparṇa and also by the word Gāyatrī. In some places, when explaining the word Śyena, Sāyaṇa explains it as शैनः शंसनीयगतिमान्पक्षि पक्ष्याकारा गायत्री (*śainaḥ śaṃsanīyagatimānpakṣi pakṣyākārā gāyatrī*). Since different words, Śyena, Suparṇa and Gāyatrī, are used in these contexts, a precise meaning cannot be stated here without knowing the narrative. So, after knowing this story as told in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa and the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa, one can examine what the principle is in the matter of the Gāyatrī bringing the Soma.

3. The incidental story of Kadrū and Suparṇī. The sons of Suparṇī are the metres.

In the Taittirīya Saṃhitā this story is described as follows:

कद्रूश्च वै सुपर्णी चात्मरूपयोरस्पर्देतागं् सा कद्रूस्सुपर्णीमजयताब्रवीत्तृतीयस्यामितो दिवि सोमस्तमाहर तेनात्मानं निष्क्रीणीष्टेतीयं वै कद्रूरसौ सुपर्णी छंदागांसि सौपर्णेयास्साब्रवीदस्मै वै पितरा पुत्रान् बिभृतस्तृतीयस्यामितो दिवि सोमस्तमाहर तेना - त्मानं निष्क्रीणीष्टेति मा कद्रूरवोचदिति जगत्युदपतच्चतुर्दशाक्षरा सती साप्राप्य न्यवर्तत तस्यै द्वे (*kadrūśca vai suparṇī cātmarūpayoraspardetāgṃ sā kadrūssuparṇīmajayatābravīttṛtīyasyāmito divi somastamāhara tenātmānaṃ niṣkrīṇīṣṭetīyaṃ vai kadrūrasau suparṇī chaṃdāgāṃsi sauparṇeyāssābravīdasmai vai pitarā putrān bibhṛtastṛtīyasyāmito divi somastamāhara tenā - tmānaṃ niṣkrīṇīṣṭeti mā kadrūravocaditi jagatyudapataccaturdaśākṣarā satī sāprāpya nyavartata tasyai dve*)

अक्षरे अमीयेतागं् सा दक्षिणाभिश्च तपसा चागच्छत्तस्मात्रिष्टुभो लोकेमाध्यंदिने सवने दक्षिणा नीयंत एतत्खलु वाव तप इत्याहुर्यस्स्वं ददातीति गायत्र्युदपतच्चतुरक्षरा सत्यजया ज्योतिषा तमस्या अजाभ्यरुंध तदजाया अजत्वगं् सा सोमं चाहरच्चत्कारि चाक्षराणि साष्टाक्षरा समपद्यत ब्रह्मवादिनो वदंति कस्मात्सत्याद्गायत्री कनिष्ठा छंदसागं् सती यज्ञमुखं परीयायेति यदेवादसोममाहरत्तस्माद्यज्ञमुखं परैत्तस्मात्तेजस्विनीतमा पद्भ्यां द्वे सवने समग्रहत्ञान्मुखेनैकं यन्मुखेन समगृह्णात्तदधयत्तस्माद्वे सवने शुक्रवशी प्रातस्सवनं च माध्यंदिनं च तस्मात्तृतीयसवन ऋजीषमभिषुण्वंति धीतमिव हि मन्यंते । (*akṣare amīyetāgṃ sā dakṣiṇābhiśca tapasā* *cāgacchattasmātriṣṭubho loke mādhyaṃdine savane dakṣiṇā nīyaṃta etatkhalu vāva tapa ityāhuryassvaṃ dadātīti gāyatryudapataccaturakṣarā satyajayā jyotiṣā tamasyā ajābhyaruṃdha tadajāyā ajatvagṃ sā somaṃ cāharaccatkāri cākṣarāṇi sāṣṭākṣarā samapadyata brahmavādino vadaṃti kasmātsatyādgāyatrī kaniṣṭhā chaṃdasāgṃ satī yajñamukhaṃ parīyāyeti yadevādasomamāharattasmādyajñamukhaṃ paraittasmāttejasvinītamā padbhāṃ dve savane samagrahñānmukhenaikaṃ yannukhena samagṛhṇāttadadhayattasmādve savane śukravaśī prātassavanaṃ ca mādhyaṃdinaṃ ca tasmāttṛtīyasavana ṛjīṣamabhiṣuṇvaṃti dhītamiva hi manyaṃte |*)

(Tai. Saṃ. 6-1-6-1 to 3)

Kadrū and Suparṇī, the two of them, came to compete as to which of them was superior in her form. Kadrū won, defeated Suparṇī and kept her in her power. Then she gave the defeated Suparṇī this assurance: "In the third part of heaven there is Soma. Bring it, and you can obtain your release." Kadrū is this earth; Suparṇī is the sky. The metres are the offspring of Suparṇī. Kadrū told Suparṇī: "With the help of the children who are nourished for the service of their mother, bring me the Soma and obtain your freedom." In the same way Suparṇī too told her children of this occasion. Then the Jagatī, of fourteen syllables, flew up to the sky. But it could not get the Soma and turned back. It lost two syllables of the fourteen, and came back with the sacrificial animals. For this very reason the Jagatī metre is rich in the wealth of animals, and a man rich in animals is fit to be consecrated. Then the Triṣṭubh metre, of thirteen syllables, flew up to the sky. It too lost two syllables and did not obtain the Soma. But when it came back, it returned with the sacrificial fee (dakṣiṇā) useful for the sacrifice and with the materials of austerity. Therefore in worldly practice the dakṣiṇā is offered at the midday pressing. One who gives away his wealth as a gift, that is called the act of austerity. Next the Gāyatrī, of four syllables, set out towards the sky together with an Aja (goat) in the form of light. That Aja made the Soma available to the Gāyatrī. Then, as the Gāyatrī came back taking the Soma, since it brought back with it the four syllables that the Triṣṭubh and the Jagatī had left behind there, these four syllables joined the four that it had before, and in all it became eight-syllabled. Thus, although it is the smallest of all the metres, because it brought the Soma, which is so important for the sacrifice, it holds a very prominent place in the sacrificial work; this is the view of the Brahmavādins. For that very reason it is the most brilliant of all the metres. That (the Gāyatrī in the form of a bird) with both feet

…it brought two savanas, the Prātaḥ and the Mādhyandina, and one from the mouth. The savana brought from the mouth it drank. For this reason the morning savana and the midday savana are accompanied by pure (white) Soma, while the third savana is accompanied by ṛjīṣa (the pressed-out residue). This is the order stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā. In the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa this account is somewhat different. It is told in two passages. First:

सोमो वै राजा गंधर्वेष्वासीत्तं देवाश्च ऋषयश्चाभ्यध्यायन्कथमयमस्मान्सोमो राजागच्छेदिति सा वागब्रवीत् स्त्रीकामा वै गंधर्वा मयैव स्त्रीया भूतया पणध्वमिति नेति देवा अब्रुवन्नथं वयं त्वदृते स्यामेति साब्रवीत्क्रीणीतैव यर्हि वाव वो मयार्थो भविता तर्ह्येव वोऽहं पुनरागंतास्मीति तथेति तया महानग्न्या भूतया सोमं राजानमक्रीणन्. (*somo vai rājā gaṃdharveṣvāsīttaṃ devāśca ṛṣayaścābhyadhyāyankathamayamasmānsomo rājāgacchediti sā vāgabravīt strīkāmā vai gaṃdharvā mayaiva strīyā bhūtayā paṇadhvamiti neti devā abruvannathaṃ vayaṃ tvadṛte syāmeti sābravītkrīṇītaiva yarhi vāva vo mayārtho bhavitā tarhyeva vo 'haṃ punarāgaṃtāsmīti tatheti tayā mahānagnyā bhūtayā somaṃ rājānamakrīṇan.*) (Ai. Brā. 5-2)

While King Soma was living among the Gandharvas, the gods and the ṛṣis, wishing to obtain him, fell to meditating on him. While they were pondering the way to obtain him, the goddess Vāk came before them and said: "The Gandharvas are fond of women. Send me; I shall bring Soma and hand him over to you." The gods said: "We cannot be without you. That will not do." Then Vāk said: "For the present send me and obtain Soma. Afterwards, as soon as you wish for me, I shall come to you." After she had given this assurance, they obtained Soma with her help. So it is said. The same occasion is told elsewhere in this manner.

4. The efforts of the metres to fetch Soma, and their defeat.

सोमो वै राजामुष्मिलोक आसीत्तं देवाश्च ऋषयश्चाभ्यध्यायन्कथमयमस्मान्सोमो राजागच्छेदिति तेऽब्रुवंशद्वासि यूयं न इमं सोमं राजानमाहरतेति तथेति ते सुपर्णा भूत्वोदपतंस्ते यत्सुपर्णा भूत्वोदपतंस्तदेतत् सौपर्णमित्याख्यानविद आचक्षते । छंदांसि नै तत्सोमं राजानमच्छाचरंस्तानि ह तर्हि चतुरक्षराणि चतुरक्षराण्येव छंदांस्यासन् सा जगती चतुरक्षरा प्रथमोदपतत्सा पतित्वार्धमध्वनो गत्वाश्राम्यता परास्य त्रीण्यक्षराण्येकाक्षरा भूत्वा दीक्षां च तपश्च हरंती पुनरभ्यवापतत्तस्मात्तस्य वित्ता दीक्षा वित्तं तपो यस्य पशवः संति जागता हि पशवो जगती हि तानादरदथ त्रिष्टुबुदपतता (*somo vai rājāmuṣmiloka āsīttaṃ devāśca ṛṣayaścābhyadhyāyankathamayamasmānsomo rājāgacchediti te 'bruvaṃśadvāsi yūyaṃ na imaṃ somaṃ rājānamāharateti tatheti te suparṇā bhūtvodapataṃste yatsuparṇā bhūtvodapataṃstadetat sauparṇamityākhyānavida ācakṣate | chaṃdāṃsi nai tatsomaṃ rājānamacchācaraṃstāni ha tarhi caturakṣarāṇi caturakṣarāṇyeva chaṃdāṃsyāsan sā jagatī caturakṣarā prathamodapatatsā patitvārdhamadhvano gatvāśrāmyatā parāsya trīṇyakṣarāṇyekākṣarā bhūtvā dīkṣāṃ ca tapaśca haraṃtī punarabhyavāpatattasmāttasya vittā dīkṣā vittaṃ tapo yasya paśavaḥ saṃti jāgatā hi paśavo jagatī hi tānādaradatha triṣṭubudapatatā*) ...

...पतित्वा भूयोऽर्धादध्वनो गत्वाश्राम्यता परास्यैकमक्षरं त्रैक्षरा भूत्वा दक्षिणा हरंती पुनरभ्यवापतत्तस्मान्माध्यंदिने दक्षिणा नीयंते त्रिष्टुभो लोके त्रिष्टुब्बि ता आहरत् । (*patitvā bhūyo 'rdhādadhvano gatvāśrāmyatā parāsyaikamakṣaraṃ traikṣarā bhūtvā dakṣiṇā haraṃtī punarabhyavāpatattasmānmādhyaṃdine dakṣiṇā nīyaṃte triṣṭubho loke triṣṭubbi tā āharat |*) (Ai. Brā. 13-25)

(The same closing line stands printed twice.)

The gods thought for a long time how the Soma that was in the atmosphere could be obtained; then they approached the metres and begged: "Bring us the Soma of the atmosphere." Giving the assurance "So be it," they took the form of birds and flew up into the atmosphere. Because they were transformed into the form of suparṇas (birds) and flew to fetch Soma, this episode became famous as the Suparṇa legend. When those metres in bird form flew toward Soma, each of them consisted of only four syllables. The four-syllabled Jagatī, flying first into the atmosphere, tired out in the middle of the way. Leaving three of her syllables there, she returned with only the remaining one syllable. But on coming back she brought the dīkṣā (consecration) and tapas (austerity). Because Jagatī is closely related to wealth in cattle, one who has wealth in cattle obtains faith and the power of austerity. Then Triṣṭubh also, having passed the middle of the way, grew tired after going only a little further. Leaving only one of her syllables there, she returned with the other three. On coming back she brought the dakṣiṇā, the requisite of the sacrifice. Therefore, at the time of the Mādhyandina savana, the dakṣiṇā has preference.

5. The victory of Gāyatrī.

ते देवा अब्रुवन्गायत्रीं त्वं न इमं सोमं राजानमाहरेति सा तथे त्यब्रवीत्तां वै मा सर्वेण स्वस्त्ययनेनानुमंत्रयध्वमिति तथेति सोदपतत्तां देवाः सर्वेण स्वस्त्ययनेनान्वमंत्रयुत प्रेति चेति चेत्येतद्वै सर्वं स्वस्त्ययनं यत्प्रीति चेति चेति तद्योऽस्य प्रियः स्यात्तमेतेनानुमंत्रयेत प्रेति चेति तद्योऽस्य प्रियः स्यात्तमेतेनानुमंत्रयेत प्रेति चेति चेति स्वस्तेव गच्छति स्वस्ति पुनरागच्छति सा पतित्वा सोमपालान् भीषयित्वा पद्भ्यां च मुखेन च सोमं राजानं समगृभ्नाड्यानि चेतरे छंदसी अक्षराण्यजहितां तानि चोपसमगृभ्णात्तस्या अनु विसृज्य कृशानुः सोमपालः सव्यस्य पदो नखमच्चिदत्तच्छल्यकोऽभवत्तस्मात्सनखमिव यद्वशमस्रवत्सा वशाभवत्तस्मात्सा हविरिवाध यः शल्यो यदनीकमासीत्स सर्पो निर्दंश्यभवत्सहसस्सजो यानि पर्णानि ते मंथावला यानि स्नावानि ते गंडूपदा यत्तेजनं सोऽंधाहिः सो सा तथेषुरभवत् । (*te devā abruvangāyatrīṃ tvaṃ na imaṃ somaṃ rājānamāhareti sā tathe tyabravīttāṃ vai mā sarveṇa svastyayanenānumaṃtrayadhvamiti tatheti sodapatattāṃ devāḥ sarveṇa svastyayanenānvamaṃtrayuta preti ceti cetyetadvai sarvaṃ svastyayanaṃ yatprīti ceti ceti tadyo 'sya priyaḥ syāttametenānumaṃtrayeta preti ceti tadyo 'sya priyaḥ syāttametenānumaṃtrayeta preti ceti ceti svasteva gacchati svasti punarāgacchati sā patitvā somapālān bhīṣayitvā padbhyāṃ ca mukhena ca somaṃ rājānaṃ samagṛbhnāḍyāni cetare chaṃdasī akṣarāṇyajahitāṃ tāni copasamagṛbhṇāttasyā anu visṛjya kṛśānuḥ somapālaḥ savyasya pado nakhamaccidattacchalyako 'bhavattasmātsanakhamiva yadvaśamasravatsā vaśābhavattasmātsā havirivādha yaḥ śalyo yadanīkamāsītsa sarpo nirdaṃśyabhavatsahasassajo yāni parṇāni te maṃthāvalā yāni snāvāni te gaṃḍūpadā yattejanaṃ so 'ṃdhāhiḥ so sā tatheṣurabhavat |*) (Ai. Brā. 13-26)

Then the gods approached Gāyatrī and prayed: "Bring us King Soma." Gāyatrī agreed, saying "So be it," and said that the gods should follow her reciting a svastyayana (auspicious) mantra. The gods gladly accepted this and set out reciting the svastyayana mantra "pra" and "ā". Because by reciting this mantra the journey is accomplished without obstacle and the purpose is achieved, the gods recited it. Gāyatrī reached the region where Soma was without obstacle, took up Soma with her feet and her mouth, and also took the four syllables (3+1) that Triṣṭubh and Jagatī had left behind, and returned. But Kṛśānu, the guardian of Soma, cut off the nail of her left foot. It was transformed into a porcupine and became a śalya (quill). The blood that flowed from it became a barren cow, and the bone-frame became a serpent; but it did not come to spit poison and bite. In the same way the feather became the bat, and the sinew the earth-worm; thus the form of the arrow became such.

6. The primacy of Gāyatrī in the times of the savanas.

सा यद्दक्षिणेन पदा समगृभ्यात्तत्पातःसवनमभवत्तद्गायत्री स्वमायतनमकुरुत तस्मात्तत्समृद्धतमं मन्यंते सर्वेषां सवनानामग्रियो मुख्यो भवति श्रेष्ठतामश्नुते य एवं वेदाथ यत्सव्येन पदा समगृभ्यात्तन्माध्यंदिनं सवनमभवत्तद्विस्स्रंसत तद्विस्स्रस्तं नान्वाप्पोत्तूर्वं सवनं ते देवाः प्राजिज्ञासंत तस्मिंस्त्रिष्टुभं छंदसामदधुरिंद्रं देवतानां तेन तत्समावद्वीर्यमभवत्तूर्वेण सवनेनोभाभ्यां सवनाभ्यां समावद्वीर्याभ्यां समावज्ञामाभ्यां राध्नोति य एवं वेदाथ यन्नुखेन समगृभ्यात्तृतीयसवनमभवत्तस्य पतंती रसमधयत्तद्धीतरसं नान्वाप्पोत्तूर्वे सवने ते देवाः प्राजिज्ञासंत तत्त्वशुष्पपश्यंस्तद्यदाशिरमवनयन्त्याज्येन पशुना चरंति तेन तत्समावद्वीर्यमभवत्तूर्वाभ्यां सवनाभ्यां सर्वैः सवनैः समावद्वीर्यैः समानाज्यामिभी राध्नोति य एवं वेद । (*sā yaddakṣiṇena padā samagṛbhyāttatpātaḥsavanamabhavattadgāyatrī svamāyatanamakuruta tasmāttatsamṛddhatamaṃ manyaṃte sarvèṣāṃ savanānāmagriyo mukhyo bhavati śreṣṭhatāmaśnute ya evaṃ vedātha yatsavyena padā samagṛbhyāttanmādhyaṃdinaṃ savanamabhavattadvissraṃsata tadvissrastaṃ nānvāppottūrvaṃ savanaṃ te devāḥ prājijñāsaṃta tasmiṃskiṣṭubhaṃ chaṃdasāmadadhuriṃdraṃ devatānāṃ tena tatsamāvadvīryamabhavattūrveṇa savanenobhābhyāṃ savanābhyāṃ samāvadvīryābhyāṃ samāvajjāmābhyāṃ rādhnoti ya evaṃ vedātha yannukhena samagṛbhyāttṛtīyasavanamabhavattasya pataṃtī rasamadhayattaddhītarasaṃ nānvāppottūrve savane te devāḥ prājijñāsaṃta tattvaśuṣpapaśyaṃstadyadāśiramavanayantyājyena paśunā caraṃti tena tatsamāvadvīryamabhavattūrvābhyāṃ savanābhyāṃ sarvaiḥ savanaiḥ samāvadvīryaiḥ samānājyāmibhī rādhnoti ya evaṃ veda* |) (Ai. Brā. 13-22)

The portion of Soma that Gāyatrī seized with her right foot became the Prātaḥsavana. This morning savana became Gāyatrī's own dwelling. Therefore the morning savana is regarded as the most prosperous of the savanas. One who knows this truth becomes foremost and chief among sacrificers. The portion of Soma that Gāyatrī seized with her left foot became the Mādhyandina savana. Because it slipped away, it did not obtain the excellence of the morning savana. The gods tried to remedy this deficiency, and placed in it Triṣṭubh among the metres and Indra among the deities…

…Thereafter it too obtained the vigour of the morning savana. The man who knows the equal strength and wealth of these two savanas prospers. The portion of Soma seized with the mouth became the third savana. While she was flying, the Śyena, in the form of Gāyatrī, drank it. Therefore it did not obtain the equality of strength of the first two savanas. The gods recognised that this deficiency must be remedied. They then looked for it among the animals, and then worshipped it with the āśira and the offering of ājya. Thereafter it too obtained the strength of the first two savanas. One who knows this truth prospers.

7. The section on the division of the syllables of the metres.

ते वा इमे इतरे छंदसी गायत्रीमभ्यवदेतां वित्तं नावक्षराण्यनुपर्यागुरिति नेत्यब्रवीद्गायत्री यथा वित्तमेव न इति ते देवेषु प्रश्नमैतां ते देवा अब्रुवन्यथावित्तमेव व इति तस्माद्याप्येतर्हि वित्तां व्याहुरथा वित्तमेव न इति ततो वा अष्टाक्षरा गायत्र्यभवत्र्यक्षरा त्रिष्टुबेकाक्षरा जगती साष्टाक्षरा गायत्री प्रातःसवनमुदयच्छन्नाशक्नोत्रिष्टुप् त्रक्षरा माध्यंदिनं समनमुद्यंतुं तां गायत्र्यब्रवीदायान्यपि मेऽत्रास्त्विति सा तथेत्यब्रवीत् त्रिष्टुप् तां वै मैत्रैरष्टाभिरक्षरैरुपसंधेहीति तथेति .... सा द्वादशाक्षरा भूत्वा तृतीयसवनमुदयच्छत्ततो वा अष्टाक्षरा गायत्र्यभवदेकादशाक्षरा त्रिष्टुब् द्वादशाक्षरा जगती सर्वेश्वंदोभिः समावद्वीर्यैः समावज्ञामिभी राध्योति य एवं वेद ॥ (*te vā ime itare chaṃdasī gāyatrīmabhyavadetāṃ vittaṃ nāvakṣarāṇyanuparyāguriti netyabravīdgāyatrī yathā vittameva na iti te deveṣu praśnamaitāṃ te devā abruvanyathāvittameva va iti tasmādyāpyetarhi vittāṃ vyāhurathā vittameva na iti tato vā aṣṭākṣarā gāyatryabhavatryakṣarā triṣṭubekākṣarā jagatī sāṣṭākṣarā gāyatrī prātaḥsavanamudayacchannāśakkotriṣṭup trakṣarā mādhyaṃdinaṃ samanamudyaṃtuṃ tāṃ gāyatryabravīdāyānyapi me 'trāstviti sā tathetyabravīt triṣṭup tāṃ vai maitrairaṣṭābhirakṣarairupasaṃdhehīti tatheti ....*

sā dvādaśākṣarā bhūtvā tṛtīyasavanamudayacchattato vā aṣṭākṣarā gāyatryabhavadekādaśākṣarā triṣṭub dvādaśākṣarā jagatī sarvèścaṃdobhiḥ samāvadvīryaiḥ samāvajñāmibhī rādhyoti ya evaṃ veda ‖) (Ai. Brā. 13-28)

After Gāyatrī had returned with the three syllables of Triṣṭubh and the one syllable of Jagatī, those two approached her and begged: "The syllables, our wealth, have come along with you. Give them back." Gāyatrī replied: "No, they are not yours; since I brought them, they have become mine." Then the two approached the gods and told their complaint. The gods took Gāyatrī's side: "Since you brought them, those four syllables have become yours. Just as in worldly dealings it is the custom that whatever property we have obtained becomes ours, so you have the right to take them as your own." Then Gāyatrī became eight-syllabled, Triṣṭubh three-syllabled, and Jagatī one-syllabled. Then Gāyatrī with her eight syllables became able to take part in the morning savana.

But Triṣṭubh, with her three syllables, could not take part in the Mādhyandina savana. Then Gāyatrī said: "I too shall take part in the Mādhyandina savana; let me too have a share of the sacrifice there." Triṣṭubh said: "So be it; join me with your eight syllables." Together, as eleven-syllabled, she became helpful to the Mādhyandina savana. Jagatī, being one-syllabled, was unable to carry out the third savana. Then Gāyatrī again asked that she join her and that she too have a share in the third savana. Jagatī agreed, "So be it," and Gāyatrī joined her at the time of the third savana. Then, as twelve-syllabled, she became helpful to the third savana. Then Gāyatrī became eight-syllabled, Triṣṭubh eleven-syllabled, and Jagatī twelve-syllabled. One who knows this truth obtains all wealth through the grace of these metres, which possess equal strength and splendour. Thus there is praise of Gāyatrī.

1. The identity of Agni, Gāyatrī and Śyena; their place in the times of the savanas.

In this way the story of the identity of this Gāyatrī with the Śyena is told in many places. Likewise in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa:

स वै खलु बर्हिः प्रथमं यजति । तद्वै कनिष्ठछंदः सद्गायत्री प्रथमा छंदसां युज्यते (*sa vai khalu barhiḥ prathamaṃ yajati | tadvai kaniṣṭhachaṃdaḥ sadgāyatrī prathamā chaṃdasāṃ yujyate*) (Śa. Brā 1-8-2-10)

Although she is the lowest of all the metres, Gāyatrī by her own greatness carried off Soma from the atmosphere. This was possible only through her own inner power. By this power she transformed herself into the Śyena and accomplished that task. For that reason the gods also showed her the first honour and revered her.

श्येनाय त्वा सोमभृते विष्णवेत्वति । तद्दायत्रीमन्वाभजति सा यद्दायत्री श्येन्नो भूत्वा दिवः सोममाभरत् ॥ (*śyenāya tvā somabhṛte viṣṇavetvati | taddāyatrīmanvābhajati sā yaddāyatrī śyenno bhūtvā divaḥ somamābharat ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 3-4-1-12)

Because Gāyatrī, in the form of the Śyena, carried off Soma from the atmosphere, the offering is addressed to the Śyena, the Soma-bearer, who has the nature of Viṣṇu; thus hospitality is offered to Gāyatrī. And so on.

Since this is said in many places of the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa — 3-9-4-10; 4-3-2-7; 1-7-1-1; 11-7-2 8 and others — one point must be noted.[?261]

श्येनाय त्वा सोमभृत इति । तद्गायत्रै मिमितेऽग्नये त्वा रायस्पोषद इत्यग्निर्वै गायत्री तद्गायत्रै मिमिते स यद्गायत्री श्येनो भूत्वा । (*śyenāya tvā somabhṛta iti | tadgāyatrai mimite 'gnaye tvā rāyaspoṣada ityagnirvai gāyatrī tadgāyatrai mimite sa yadgāyatrī śyeno bhūtvā |*) .... (Śa. Brā 3-9-4-10)

Thus identity is stated among Gāyatrī, Śyena and Agni. This unity of Agni and Gāyatrī, in which Gāyatrī, being of the nature of Agni, fetched Soma in the form of the Śyena, is supported also by the passages of the Ṛk Saṃhitā:

अग्नेर्गायत्र्यभवत् सयुग्योष्ठिहया सविता सं बभूव । अनुष्टुभा सोम उक्थैर्महस्वान् बृहस्पतेर्बृहती वाचमावत् ॥ (*agnergāyatryabhavat sayugyoṣṭhihayā savitā saṃ babhūva | anuṣṭubhā soma ukthairmahasvān bṛhaspaterbṛhatī vācamāvat ‖*) (18-130-4)[?262]

Here it is stated that Gāyatrī, closely related to Agni, became Agni's helper. The same is stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā: निरमिमीत तमग्निर्देवतान्नसृज्यत गायत्रि छंदः (*niramimīta tamagnirdevatānnasṛjyata* *gāyatri chaṃdaḥ*) (7-1-1-4). Not mere close relation only: there are abundant authorities such as गायत्रि वा अग्निः (*gāyatri vā agniḥ*); गायत्रोऽग्निः (*gāyatro 'gniḥ*); अग्निर्वै गायत्रि (*agnirvai gāyatri*); गायत्रमग्नेश्छंदः (*gāyatramagneśchaṃdaḥ*) (Śa. Brā. 6-1-3-19; Tai. Brā. 1-1-5-3; Tai. Saṃ. 2 2-5-5 and others)[?263]. In all these identity is stated. Moreover, Agni and Gāyatrī are both deities connected with the morning savana. Stating this, the Nirukta says:

तिस्र एव देवताः इत्युक्तं पुरस्तात् तासां भक्तिसाहचर्यं व्याख्यानस्यामः । अथैतान्यग्निभक्तान्ययं लोकः प्रातःसवनं वसंतो गायत्री । (*tisra eva devatāḥ ityuktaṃ purastāt tāsāṃ bhaktisāhacaryaṃ vyākhyānasyāmaḥ | athaitānyagnibhaktānyayaṃ lokaḥ prātaḥsavanaṃ vasaṃto gāyatrī |*) (Ni. 7-8)

Earlier, when speaking of the deities, it was stated that three deities are the chief ones and all the others are their special manifestations. Among them, as to Agni's association and who share in the sacrifice: this earth, the morning savana, spring, Gāyatrī and so on; thus the unity of Agni, Gāyatrī and the morning savana is stated. The Maitrī Upaniṣad too states the same matter:

अग्निर्गायित्रं त्रिवृद्रथंतरं वसंतः प्राणो नक्षत्राणि वसवः । (*agnirgāyatraṃ trivṛdrathaṃtaraṃ vasaṃtaḥ prāṇo nakṣatrāṇi vasavaḥ |*) (Mai. U. 7-1)

And further:

अग्ने जुषस्व नो हविः पुरोळाशं जातवेदः । प्रातःसावे धियावसो ॥ (*agne juṣasva no haviḥ puroḷāśaṃ jātavedaḥ | prātaḥsāve dhiyāvaso ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-28-1)

The Agni-hymn (आग्नेयं हि प्रातः सवनं (*āgneyaṃ hi prātaḥ savanaṃ*) Śa. Brā. 3-4-9-12) and भूरग्निर्ज्योतिरग्निरिति (*bhūragnirjyotiragniriti*) and what follows (Ai. Brā. 2-32): in this way the direct connection between the morning pressing and Agni is well known from the Śruti. Further: वसवस्तर्हग्निः। तस्मिन् यस्य तथाविधे जुह्वति।वसुष्टेवास्याग्निहोत्रग्ं हुतं भवति । (*vasavastarhagniḥ| tasmin yasya tathāvidhe juhvati| vasuṣṭevāsyāgnihotragṃ hutaṃ bhavati* |) (Tai. Brā. 2-1-10-1). Having thus stated the identity of Agni and the Vasus, it praises the matter by saying that an oblation offered in Agni is as if offered to the Vasus. For this very reason the deity who takes part in the morning pressing along with the Gāyatrī is indicated in some places as Agni and in others as the Vasus.

चतुर्विंशत्यक्षरा गायत्री गायत्रं प्रातःसवनं तदस्य वसवोऽन्वायत्ताः प्राणा एव वसव एते हीदं सर्वं वासयंति । ((*caturviṃśatyakṣarā gāyatrī gāyatraṃ prātaḥsavanaṃ tadasya vasavo 'nvāyattāḥ prāṇā eva vasava ete hīdaṃ sarvaṃ vāsayaṃti* | *()* (Bhā. 81, 3-6-1)[?264]

The morning pressing is offered together with the Gāyatrī mantra (metre) of twenty-four syllables; the Vasus are those entitled to this share of the sacrifice. In the context of stating in this way the direct connection of Agni and the Gāyatrī, what is relevant for us is to examine whether these three, Agni, Śyena and Gāyatrī, all indicate one identity, or are different principles.

नवं नु स्तोममग्नये दिवः श्वेनाय जीजनं । वस्वः कुविद्वनाति नः ॥ (*navaṃ nu stomamagnaye divaḥ śvenāya jījanaṃ* | *vasvaḥ kuvidvanāti naḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-15-4)

Here Agni is designated as the Śyena of the heaven-world. The same sentence is cited in the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa (Tai. Brā. 2-4-8-1). The words दिवः शैनः (*divaḥ śainaḥ*) are used in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā, besides the mantra cited above, in two Ṛks, 7-56-3 and 10-92-6; but in those passages the word Śyena tells the nature of the Marut deities. If, however, Agni is regarded as belonging to lightning, then this word Śyena can apply to Agni also; this conclusion can be drawn on the strength of sentences such as वैश्वानरो यदि वा वैद्युतोऽसि (*vaiśvānaro yadi vā vaidyuto 'si*) (Tai. Brā. 3-10-5). In the Ṛk-Saṃhitā too support for this conclusion is found: गर्भे मातुः ओतुष्टिता विदिद्युतानो अक्षरे (*garbhe mātuḥ òtuṣṭitā vididyutāno akṣare*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-16 35)[?265]. The Gāyatrī, which has Agni as her food or accompaniment, is likewise described with the epithet विदिद्युदती (*vididyudatī*) (Pañcaviṃśa Brāhmaṇa 12-1-)[?266]. The commentator, explaining this Brāhmaṇa sentence, says: गायत्री च अग्निना सरोत्पत्तेस्तेजोरूपत्वात् दीप्यमाना भवति । अतः .... गायत्री एवोपस्थाते ॥ (*gāyatrī ca agninā sarotpattestejorūpatvāt dīpyamānā bhavati* | *ataḥ .... gāyatrī evopasthāte* ‖)

Since the Gāyatrī too was born together with Agni, the epithet विदिद्युदती (*vididyudatī*) that applies to Agni applies to the Gāyatrī as well. As in the sentence तेजो गायत्री (*tejo gāyatrī*) (Tai. Brā. 3-8-4), just as

Agni is of the form of brilliance, the Gāyatrī too has the form of brilliance. In Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-3-8 and 10-95-10 also the word दविद्योत् (*davidyot*) is connected with the word विद्युत् (*vidyut*)

In the Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa, in the context of the Divaḥ-Śyena offering (3-12-1, 2), the mantra तुभ्यं ता अंगिरस्तम (*tubhyaṃ tā aṃgirastama*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 8-43-18) clearly points to Agni; and in the same context the mantra अश्याम तं काममग्ने (*aśyāma taṃ kāmamagne*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-5-7) also is addressed to Agni. Therefore there is no doubt that the epithet दिवःशैन (*divaḥśaina*) is a description of Agni. Further, is there a context in which the word सुपर्ण (*suparṇa*) too, just as it indicates the Śyena, indicates Agni? If so, what its meaning is must also be examined. Although this word Suparṇa is merely a synonym of "bird", in many places it has a hidden meaning. For example:

सुपर्णं विप्राः कवयो वचोभिरेकं संतं बहुधा कल्पयंति । (*suparṇaṃ viprāḥ kavayo vacobhirekaṃ saṃtaṃ bahudhā kalpayaṃti |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-114 5)

Here, according to Sāyaṇa, it is an epithet of the Supreme Self; he explains सुपर्णं सुपतनं एकं संतं परमात्मानं (*suparṇaṃ supatanaṃ ekaṃ saṃtaṃ paramātmānaṃ*). This meaning of the principle will have to be examined later. In the present context, where the word Suparṇa is used with reference to the Āditya or Agni, it is explained as "rays":

यत्रा सुपर्णा अमृतस्य भागमनिमेषं विदथाभिस्स्वरंति । (*yatrā suparṇā amṛtasya bhāgamanimeṣaṃ vidathābhissvaraṃti |*) (1-164-21)

यस्मिन्वृक्षे मध्वदः सुपर्णा निविशंते सुवते चाधिविश्वे ॥ (*yasminvṛkṣe madhvadaḥ suparṇā niviśaṃte suvate cādhiviśve ‖*) (1-164.22)

In such places, when the material meaning is given, they are called the rays of the Āditya. The word Suparṇa is also used as a synonym for Agni or the Āditya: दिव्यं सुपर्णं वायसं बृहंतमपां गर्भं दर्शतनोषधीनां । (*divyaṃ suparṇaṃ vāyasaṃ bṛhaṃtamapāṃ garbhaṃ darśatanoṣadhīnāṃ |*) (1-164-52); this description indicates Agni who dwells in the middle region. In the places दिवः श्येनः (*divaḥ śyenaḥ*) and दिव्यं सुपर्णं (*divyaṃ suparṇaṃ*) the identity of Agni and the Āditya is what is stated. Thus it is understood that Śyena, Suparṇa, Agni and Gāyatrī are all synonyms of one principle; but the technical meaning has to be explained according to each context.

Śrī Rāmacandra.

1. Soma is the brilliance of the Āditya; the Gāyatrī is the chief means for knowing this.

In the present context, if the word Śyena is taken to mean Agni of the middle region or the Āditya, then the word Soma comes to mean the seed (retas) of that Āditya. That is, for the Supreme Brahman who is in the form of the Āditya also, Soma is present in the form of seed. This Soma is the seed that produces the creation of all beings.

अथ यत्किंचेदमार्द्रं तद्रेतसोऽसृजत तदु सोम एतवद्वा इदं सर्वमन्नं चैवान्नादश्च सोम एवान्नमग्निरन्नादः । (*atha yatkiṃcedamārdraṃ tadretaso 'sṛjata tadu soma etavadvā idaṃ sarvamannaṃ caivānnādaśca soma evānnamagnirannādaḥ |*) (Bṛ. U. 1-4-6)

The one Supreme Brahman created from his seed all the moist things in the world. That seed is Soma. This Soma, offered in Agni, becomes with it mutually food and eater. Explaining this very matter, the Maitrī Upaniṣad says:

रविमध्ये स्थितः सोमः सोममध्ये हुताशनः । (*ravimadhye sthitaḥ somaḥ somamadhye hutāśanaḥ |*) (Mai. U. 6-38)[?267]

It states that Soma stands in the middle of the orb of the Āditya, and Agni in the middle of Soma. The relation between the Āditya and Soma is stated in many places of the Ṛk-Saṃhitā. For example:

महत्तत्सोमो महिषश्च कारापां यद्दर्भोऽवृणीत देवान् । (*mahattatsomo mahiṣaśca kārāpāṃ yaddarbho 'vṛṇīta devān |*)

आदधादिंद्रे पवमान ओजोऽजनयत्सूर्ये ज्योतिरिंदुः ॥ (*ādadhādiṃdre pavamāna ojo 'janayatsūrye jyotiriṃduḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-97-41)

Soma, the embryo of the waters that are in the Āditya, brought satisfaction to the gods; being in the form of virile power, it created in the Āditya the light of the universe. And:

त्वं समुद्रो आसि विश्ववित्कवे तवेमाः पंच प्रदिशो विधर्मणि । (*tvaṃ samudro āsi viśvavitkave tavemāḥ paṃca pradiśo vidharmaṇi |*)

त्वं द्यां च पृथिवीं चाति जभ्रिषे तव ज्योतींषि पवमान सूर्यः ॥ (*tvaṃ dyāṃ ca pṛthivīṃ cāti jabhriṣe tava jyotīṃṣi pavamāna sūryaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-86-29)

Here it is stated that Soma is the ocean of the middle region, the support of all light, and that the Āditya shines by Soma's power. Explaining what principle Soma reflects here, the scholar Eggeling has said as follows:

"The poet of 9-86-29 while saying ' Thou art the heavenly ocean (Samudra), thine are the lights (ज्योतींषि (*jyotīṃṣi*)) O Pavamana, thine the Sun ' seems to conceive Soma, as the bright ether, the azure ' Sea of light ' generally ". [Sacred Books of the East. Vol. XXVI. p. XV.]

Thus, on the basis of Śruti sentences, they hold that Soma is the luminous essence of the Āditya. The purport is that the nature of such brilliance is obtainable only with the help of the Gāyatrī.

Secondly, what is the place of the Gāyatrī in the story cited from the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa: सोमो वै राजा गंधर्वेष्वासीत्.... ....तया महानग्न्या भूतया सोमं राजानमक्रीणन् (*somo vai rājā gaṃdharveṣvāsīt.... ....tayā mahānagnyā bhūtayā somaṃ rājānamakrīṇan*) (Ai. Brā. 1-27)? There is no reason for the doubt that here the bringing of Soma was done by a woman in the form of Speech, and that the Gāyatrī has no connection with Soma. Here the word Gandharva must be taken to mean the Āditya, the word Soma the brilliance of the Āditya, and the word Vāk the Gāyatrī in the form of speech. If it is asked what is the authority for this, the Śruti sentences themselves are the authority.

1. The Gandharva who guarded the Soma, the brilliance of the Āditya, is Hiraṇyagarbha.

गंधर्व इत्था पदमस्य रक्षति पाति देवानां जनिमान्यद्भुतः । (*gaṃdharva itthā padamasya rakṣati pāti devānāṃ janimānyadbhutaḥ |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-83-4)

गंधर्वः उदकानां धारकः आदित्यः सोमस्य द्युसंबंधिस्थानं रक्षति । (*gaṃdharvaḥ udakānāṃ dhārakaḥ ādityaḥ somasya dyusaṃbaṃdhisthānaṃ rakṣati* |) The Āditya, the bearer of the waters, guards the dwelling-place of Soma. There is a praise of the Āditya saying that this Soma protects the gods. This same Gandharva is also designated as Hiraṇyagarbha. On the sentence पतंगो वाचं मनसा बिभर्ति तां गंधर्वोऽवदद्गर्भे अंतः (*pataṃgo vācaṃ manasā bibharti tāṃ gaṃdharvo 'vadadgarbhe aṃtaḥ*) (10-177-2)

Sāyaṇa says: गर्भे हिरण्मये ब्रह्मांडेऽंतर्वर्तमानः गंधर्वः हिरण्यगर्भः तां वाचमवदत् । (*garbhè hiraṇmaye brahmāṃḍe 'ṃtarvartamānaḥ gaṃdharvaḥ hiraṇyagarbhaḥ tāṃ vācamavadat* |)

The Gandharva, of the form of Hiraṇyagarbha, who is within the Brahmāṇḍa, first uttered the Speech lodged in himself; afterwards the gods, seers of the end (of things), placed that Speech in the place of truth. Thus the relation between the Supreme Self, of the nature of the Āditya, and Speech is described. The story of the bringing of Soma told in the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa tells of the relation between this Supreme Person, who is within the Āditya, and the principle of Speech, and afterwards how Soma, the brilliance of the Āditya, became the protector of the gods.

दिवि वै सोम आसीत् ।....गंधर्वो विश्वावसुः पर्यमुष्णात् ।....सोमो वै भ्राट् । (*divi vai soma āsīt |....gaṃdharvo viśvāvasuḥ paryamuṣṇāt |....somo vai bhrāṭ* |) (Śa. Brā. 3-2-4-4)

By these sentences the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa tells the story cited earlier from the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa. Here too it tells the manner in which the Gāyatrī, in the form of speech, carried off the Soma; the manner in which this Soma, in the form of brilliance, was contained within the Gandharva in the form of the Āditya; and that afterwards this brilliance is obtained by the man who worships the goddess Speech. By sentences such as सोमो वै भ्राट् (*somo vai bhrāṭ*) Soma is described as brilliance itself. The meaning is that the brilliance of the nature of Soma, from the Gandharva in the form of the Āditya, becomes obtainable through the Gāyatrī, which is of the nature of speech, and by means of this Gāyatrī, to the man who performs the worship. Thus, with Śruti sentences as proofs, for the words Suparṇa, Soma, Gandharva,

Vāk and so on, the purport stated is not improper; this can be shown by citing it together with Sāyaṇa's commentary, and the explanation above can also be shown to be consistent.

चतुष्कपर्दा युवतिः सुपेशा धृतप्रतीका वयुनानि वस्ते । (*catuṣkapardā yuvatiḥ supeśā dhṛtapratīkā vayunāni vaste* |)

तस्यां सुपर्णा वृषणा नि षेदतुर्यत्र देवा दधिरे भागधेयं ॥ (*tasyāṃ suparṇā vṛṣaṇā ni ṣedaturyatra devā dadhire bhāgadheyaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-114-3)

Here, and in the following mantras of this same sūkta, Sāyaṇa gives two kinds of purport: one an explanation that tells a material principle, the other one that explains a spiritual principle. In this cited mantra the meaning is that the Suparṇas are established in Speech. The woman who has four braids (kaparda), namely noun, verb, preposition and particle, who is of ever-youthful form, of the nature of the shining Upaniṣad and the like, adorns herself with garments in the form of knowledge. In such a beautiful woman the individual self and the Supreme Self are established. The meaning is that the principle of light, described as of the nature of Suparṇa and Gandharva, can be realised only through the woman in the form of Speech. Sāyaṇa holds that this is what is described by योषित्कामा वै गंधर्वाः (*yoṣitkāmā vai gaṃdharvāḥ*) and the like (Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa commentary 3-2-4-5).

सुपर्णं विप्राः कवयो वचोभिरेकं संतं बहुधा कल्पयंति । (*suparṇaṃ viprāḥ kavayo vacobhirekaṃ saṃtaṃ bahudhā kalpayaṃti |*)

छंदांसि च दधतो अध्वरेषु ग्रहान्त्सोमस्य मिमते द्वादश ॥ (*chaṃdāṃsi ca dadhato adhvareṣu grahāntsomasya mimate dvādaśa ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-114-2)

In Ṛks of this kind also the above view is what is explained. Stating the relation among the Supreme Self in the form of Suparṇa, the metres such as Gāyatrī, and Soma as the means of worship, the purport is that the nature of the Supreme Self can be known with the help of metres such as Gāyatrī and by the means in the form of Soma. In all such contexts there is a praise of the Gāyatrī, which possesses a special power either as the direct means of knowledge or as a supporter of the rite that is a means of knowledge.

It was stated earlier that the Ācārya says in the Śaṅkara-bhāṣya that the Gāyatrī is the most important means for realising the Supreme Brahman, and that the greatness of the Gāyatrī is known from three points. Of these, the first, namely the manner of the bringing of Soma and its purpose, and the purport of the statement that the Gāyatrī carried off Soma, has been stated along with proofs from Śruti sentences. Of the points stated by Śaṅkarācārya, the second must now be examined.

The distinctiveness of the Gāyatrī among the metres.

इतश्चंदोक्षराहरणेन.... अनेकेषु छंदस्सु गायत्रा एव ब्रह्मज्ञानद्वारतयोपादानं प्राधान्यं । (*itaścaṃdokṣarāharaṇena.... anekeṣu chaṃdassu gāyatrā eva brahmajñānadvāratayopādānaṃ prādhānyaṃ |*)[?268]

The praise that the Gāyatrī is pre-eminent because it pervades all the other metres and has unified everything in itself is well known in the Śruti sentences themselves.

तद्वै कनिष्ठं छंदः सद्गायत्री प्रथमा छंदसां युज्यते तदु तद्वीर्येणैव यच्छ्येनो भूत्वा दिवः सोममाभरत् । (*tadvai kaniṣṭhaṃ chaṃdaḥ sadgāyatrī prathamā chaṃdasāṃ yujyate tadu tadviryeṇaiva yacchyeno bhūtvā divaḥ somamābharat |*) (Śa. Brā. 1-6-2-10)

Although it is the smallest in form among all metres, the Gāyatrī holds the foremost place among all metres. The explanation that by its own power it was transformed into the form of the Śyena and brought the Soma has been given above. Moreover, it has been stated earlier, citing sentences of the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, that it added its own eight syllables to the Triṣṭubh, which remained with three syllables, and made it of eleven syllables; and that the Jagatī, which remained with one syllable, joined with the Triṣṭubh united with the Gāyatrī and was made to become of twelve syllables (Ai. Brā. 13-28).

गायत्री कनिष्ठा छंदसागं सती यज्ञमुखं परीयाय । (*gāyatrī kaniṣṭhā chaṃdasāgaṃ satī yajñamukhaṃ parīyāya |*) (Tai. Saṃ. 6-1-6-3)

अधातः शिरः । तद्गायत्रीषु भवत्यग्रं वै छंदसां गायत्र्यग्रमंगानां शिरः । (*adhātaḥ śiraḥ | taddāyatrīṣu bhavatyagraṃ vai chaṃdasāṃ gāyatryagramaṃgānāṃ śiraḥ |*) (Ai. Ā. 1-4-1)

It is stated that just as the head is the chief of all the limbs of the body, so the Gāyatrī is the chief of all metres, and that afterwards the remaining metres were constructed on its basis. For this very reason गायत्री छंदसां माता (*gāyatrī chaṃdasāṃ mātā*) (Tai. U. 4-15-1)[?269]: the Gāyatrī is praised as the mother of all metres. All the other metres are formed on the basis of this metre. In the Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya (Ai. Ā.

10-4-1)[?270] there is the explanation, for the Aitareya Āraṇyaka sentence छंदसां माता (*chaṃdasāṃ mātā*), that the other metres are constructed on its basis: इतरेषां छंदसामस्येव चतुश्चतुरक्षराधिक्येन तत्तच्छंदोभिः प्रतिमिवीते ॥ (*itareṣāṃ chaṃdasāmasyèva catuścaturakṣarādhikyena tattacchaṃdobhiḥ pratimivīte* ‖) How this is so: if the Gāyatrī metre has twenty-four syllables—

Uṣṇik 24+4 = 28

Anuṣṭubh 24+4+4 = 32

Bṛhatī 24+4+4+4 = 36

Paṅkti 24+4+4+4+4+4 = 40[?271]

Triṣṭup: 24+4+4+4+4+4 = 44.

Jagatī: 24+4+4+4+4+4+4 = 48.

The purport is that, taking the Gāyatrī as the base, the Uṣṇik and the rest are formed by adding four syllables each time. Moreover, Agni is the chief of all sacrifices, and the Gāyatrī metre is a synonym of Agni, so it is the head of all (the metres).

. गायत्रं पुरस्ताद्गायति । अग्निर्वैगायत्रमग्निमेवास्यैतच्छिरः करोत्यथो शिरः ॥ ((*. gāyatraṃ purastādgāyati | agnirvaigāyatramagnimevāsyaitacchiraḥ karotyatho śiraḥ ‖ ()* (Śa. Brā. 9-1-2-35)

Thus its primacy is praised.

शिरो वै यज्ञ स्यातिथ्यं सवाक्षरा वै गायत्री अष्टौ तानि यान्यन्वाह प्रणवो नवमः पूर्वार्धो वै यज्ञस्य गायत्री ॥ (*śiro vai yajña syātithyaṃ savākṣarā vai gāyatrī aṣṭau tāni yānyanvāha praṇavo navamaḥ pūrvārdho vai yajñasya gāyatrī ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 3-4-1-15)

The Gāyatrī consists of nine syllables. The praṇava is one; the other eight belong to the Gāyatrī that is its root form. The Gāyatrī is the chief of the whole sacrifice. Why? Because:

यो गायत्रीं हरिणीं ।.... यजमानग्ग् स्वर्गं लोकमभिवहंतीं । (*yo gāyatrīṃ hariṇīṃ |.... yajamānagg svargaṃ lokamabhivahaṃtīṃ |*) (Śa. Brā. 11-4-1-8)

Such a meritorious Gāyatrī is praised as carrying the sacrificer to heaven. Such is the power of the Gāyatrī.

The Gāyatrī pervades all the savanas

Śaṅkarācārya has shown a third point to prove that the Gāyatrī plays the most important part in the sacrifice: सर्वसवनव्यापकत्वाच्छ यज्ञस्य प्राधान्यं गायत्र्याः (*sarvasavanavyāpakatvāccha yajñasya prādhānyaṃ gāyatryāḥ*). In these three rites too, the Prātaḥsavana, the Mādhyandinasavana and the Tṛtīyasavana, the help of the Gāyatrī is absolutely necessary for performing the prescribed work; this is known from Brāhmaṇa and other passages.

गायत्री वै प्रातःसवनं वहति । त्रिष्टुप्माध्यंदिनग्ंसवनं जगतीतृतीयसवनं तद्वा अनेकाकिन्येव त्रिष्टुप्माध्यंदिनग्ंसवनं वहति गायत्रा च बृहत्या चानेकाकिनी जगतीतृतीयसवनं गायत्रोष्णिहककुभ्यामनुष्टुभा । गायत्रैवैकाकिनी प्रातःसवनं वहति । (*gāyatrī vai prātaḥsavanaṃ vahati | triṣṭupmādhyaṃdinagṃsavanaṃ jagatītṛtīyasavanaṃ tadvā anekākinyeva triṣṭupmādhyaṃdinagṃsavanaṃ vahati gāyatrā ca bṛhatyā cānekākinī jagatītṛtīyasavanaṃ gāyatroṣṭhihakakubhyāmanuṣṭubhā | gāyatraivaikākinī prātaḥsavanaṃ vahati |*) (Śa. Brā. 4-2-4-10)

The Gāyatrī carries the Prātaḥsavana, the Triṣṭup the Mādhyandinasavana, and the Jagatī the Tṛtīyasavana. But the Triṣṭup cannot carry the Mādhyandinasavana without the help of the Gāyatrī. Only when the Gāyatrī, joined with the Bṛhatī,

helps the Triṣṭup can it do so. In the same way the Jagatī too cannot carry the Tṛtīyasavana without the help of the Gāyatrī; it can do so only with the help of the Gāyatrī joined with the Kakubh and the Uṣṇik. But the Gāyatrī alone can carry the Prātaḥsavana without seeking the help of any other metre. Because the Gāyatrī pervades all the savanas, it has primacy in the sacrifice.

The question may be asked: although the Triṣṭup has eleven syllables, the Jagatī twelve and the Gāyatrī only eight, why does the Gāyatrī have this greatness? The answer: it was only through the power of the Gāyatrī that the Triṣṭup and the Jagatī came to have more syllables. This was shown above by citing passages of the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa. That the pervasion of all the savanas also came to the Gāyatrī through that distinction is shown in the Śatapatha too, as follows. Since the account differs somewhat in order, these passages are also cited.

चतुरक्षराणि ह वा आग्रे छंदाग्स्यासुः । ततो जगती सोममच्छापतत्सा श्रीण्यक्षराणि हित्वाजगाम ततस्त्रिष्टुप्सोममच्छापतत्सैकमक्षरग्ं हित्वाजगाम ततो गायत्री सोममच्छापतत्सैतानि चाक्षराणि हरदित्यागच्छत्सोमं च ततोऽष्टाक्षरा गायत्र्यभवत्तस्मादाहुरष्टाक्षरा गायत्री । (श. ब्रा. ४-३-२-७) पूर्वदल्लि छंदस्सुगळिगॆल्ला नाल्कु अक्षरगळु मात्रविद्दवु. सोमाहरणक्कागि जगतियु हारिदाग बळलि मूरु अक्षरगळन्नु दारियल्लि बिट्टु ऒंदक्षरदॊंदिगॆ मात्र हिंतिरुगितु. नंतर त्रिष्टुप्पु हारि ऒंदक्षरवन्नु बिट्टु हिंतुरिगितु. गायत्रियु स्वशक्तियिंद सोमवन्नु तरुवुदर जॊतॆगॆ अल्लि बिट्टु बंदिद्द नाल्कक्षरगळन्नू हिंदक्कॆ तंदितु. आदुदरिंद गायत्रियु अष्टाक्षरात्मक वागि अष्टाक्षरा गायत्री (*caturakṣarāṇi ha vā āgre chaṃdāgsyāsuḥ | tato jagatī somamacchāpatatsā śrīṇyakṣarāṇi hitvājagāma tatastriṣṭupsomamacchāpatatsaikamakṣaragṃ hitvājagāma tato gāyatrī somamacchāpatatsaitāni cākṣarāṇi haradityāgacchatsomaṃ ca tato 'ṣṭākṣarā gāyatryabhavattasmādāhuraṣṭākṣarā gāyatrī | (śa. brā. 4-3-2-7) pūrvadalli chaṃdassugaḷigèllā nālku akṣaragaḷu mātraviddavu. somāharaṇakkāgi jagatiyu hāridāga baḷali mūru akṣaragaḷannu dāriyalli biṭṭu òṃdakṣaradòṃdigè mātra hiṃtirugitu. naṃtara triṣṭuppu hāri òṃdakṣaravannu biṭṭu hiṃturigitu. gāyatriyu svaśaktiyiṃda somavannu taruvudara jòtègè alli biṭṭu baṃdidda nālkakṣaragaḷannū hiṃdakkè taṃditu. ādudariṃda gāyatriyu aṣṭākṣarātmaka vāgi aṣṭākṣarā gāyatrī*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-2-7)

In the beginning all the metres had only four syllables. When the Jagatī flew to fetch the Soma, it grew tired, left three syllables on the way, and returned with only one. Then the Triṣṭup flew, left one syllable, and returned. The Gāyatrī, by its own power, brought the Soma and also brought back the four syllables left behind there. Therefore the Gāyatrī, being of eight syllables, became famous as "the eight-syllabled Gāyatrī".

तया प्रातःसवनमतन्वत । तस्माद्गायत्रं प्रातःसवनमतन्वत ताग्ंह त्रिष्टुबुवाचोप त्वाहमायानि त्रिभिरक्षरैरुप मा ह्वयस्व मा मा यज्ञादंतर्गा इति तथेति तामुपाह्वयत तत एकादशाक्षरा त्रिष्टुबभवत्तस्मादाहुस्त्रैष्णुभं माध्यंदिनग्ं सवनमिति ॥ (*tayā prātaḥsavanamatanvata | tasmādgāyatraṃ prātaḥsavanamatanvata tāgṃha triṣṭubuvācopa tvāhamāyāni tribhirakṣarairupa mā hvayasva mā mā yajñādaṃtargā iti tatheti tāmupāhvayata tata ekādaśākṣarā triṣṭubabhavattasmādāhustraiṣṇubhaṃ mādhyaṃdinagṃ savanamiti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-2-8)

They performed the Prātaḥsavana with the Gāyatrī of such distinction. Therefore the Prātaḥsavana belongs to the Gāyatrī. With the help of the same Gāyatrī they began to perform the

Mādhyandinasavana also. Then the Triṣṭup came and begged the Gāyatrī: "I too shall take part with the three syllables left to me; do not leave me without a share in the sacrifice." The Gāyatrī agreed and gave it room too. Therefore the Triṣṭup metre, united with the Gāyatrī, came to have eleven syllables.

तय्यैव तृतीयसवनमतन्वत । तागं् ह जगत्युवाचोप त्वाहमायान्येकेनाक्षरेणोप मा ह्वयस्व मा मा यज्ञादंतर्गा इति तथेति तामुपाह्वयत ततो द्वादशाक्षरा जगत्यभवत्तस्मादाहुर्जागतं तृतीयसवनमिति । (*tayyaiva tṛtīyasavanamatanvata | tāgṃ ha jagatyuvācopa tvāhamāyānyekenākṣareṇopa mā hvayasva mā mā yajñādaṃtargā iti tatheti tāmupāhvayata tato dvādaśākṣarā jagatyabhavattasmādāhurjāgataṃ tṛtīyasavanamiti |*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-2-9)

With the same Gāyatrī they began to perform the Tṛtīyasavana also. Then the Jagatī approached the Gāyatrī and said: "Do not leave me without a share in the sacrifice. I too shall join you with my one remaining syllable." The Gāyatrī agreed. The Jagatī, joined with the eight syllables of the Gāyatrī and again with those three syllables with which the Gāyatrī had joined the Triṣṭup, came to have twelve syllables. Therefore the Tṛtīyasavana is famed as belonging to the Jagatī.

तदाहुः । गायत्राणि वै सर्वाणि सवनानि गायत्रि ह्येवैतदुपस्पजमानैदिति तस्मात्सगं्सिद्धं प्रातःसवने प्रतिगृह्णीयात् सगं्सिद्धा हि गायत्रागच्छत् ॥ (*tadāhuḥ | gāyatrāṇi vai sarvāṇi savanāni gāyatri hyevaitadupaspajamānaiditi tasmātsagṃsiddhaṃ prātaḥsavane pratigṛhṇīyāt sagṃsiddhā hi gāyatrāgacchat ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 4-3-2-10)

Because of this pervasion of all the savanas, all the savanas belong to the Gāyatrī. The sacrificers know that only the Gāyatrī kept growing. Since the Gāyatrī, unlike the other metres, suffered no deficiency and was not incomplete, it is praised, and the mantra signifying its victory must be recited in full. If one such mantra is taken as an example and examined, it becomes clear that it contains both the pre-eminence of the Gāyatrī metre and a prayer addressed to the deity Savitṛ, who is designated a Gandharva.

असौ वा आदित्यो देवः सविता.... ....दिव्यो गंधर्वः केतपूः केतं नः पुनात्वित्यसौ वा आदित्यो दिव्यो गंधर्वः । इमं नो देव सवितर्यज्ञं प्रणयेति । असौ वा आदित्यो देवः सविता यदु वा एष यज्ञियं कर्म प्रणयति तदनार्तग्ग् स्वस्तु दृचमश्नुते देवाव्यमिति यो देवानवदित्येतत्सखविदग्ग्

सत्राजितं धनजितग् स्वर्जितमिति य एतत्सर्वं विंदादित्ये तदृचेत्यृचा स्तोमगां समर्धय गायत्रेण रथंतरं बृहद्वायत्रवर्तनीति सामानि स्वाहेति..... ॥ तान्येतान्यष्ट् सावित्राणि । अष्टाक्षरा गायत्री गायत्रोऽग्निर्यावानग्निर्यावत्यस्य मात्रा ॥ (*asau vā ādityo devaḥ savitā.... ....divyo gaṃdharvaḥ ketapūḥ ketaṃ naḥ punātvityasau vā ādityo divyo gaṃdharvaḥ | imaṃ no deva savitaryajñaṃ praṇayeti | asau vā ādityo devaḥ savitā yadu vā eṣa yajjiyaṃ karma praṇayati tadanārtagg svastu dṛcamaśnute devāvyamiti yo devānavadityetatsakhavidagg satrājitaṃ dhanajitagg svarjitamiti ya etatsarvaṃ viṃdāditye tadṛcetyṛcā stòmagāṃ samardhaya gāyatreṇa rathaṃtaraṃ bṛhaddāyatravartanīti sāmāni svāheti..... ‖ tānyetānyaṣṭ sāvitrāṇi | aṣṭākṣarā gāyatrī gāyatro 'gniryāvānagniryāvatyasya mātrā ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 6-3-1-19, 21)

The Vājasaneyi Saṃhitā sentence (11-7), "O god Savitṛ, urge on our sacrifice quickly, so that it is accomplished without obstacle," is to be recited. The god Savitṛ is Āditya. All the sacrificial share belongs to him. The prayer is: "May Savitṛ, the purifier of the mind and the Gandharva of the atmosphere, who is Āditya, cause the sacrifice to be accomplished completely." If the Rathantara sāman is joined with the Gāyatrī metre and the Bṛhat sāman with the Gāyatrī measure, and an efficacious mantra is composed and recited, it always secures prosperity and heaven. The mantras recited in prayer to Savitṛ are eight in number; since the Gāyatrī consists of eight syllables, the number of these mantras is also eight. Since Agni, the chief of the whole sacrifice, is Gāyatra, Agni's glory is the glory of the Gāyatrī; thus the primacy of the Gāyatrī at the time of sacrifice is declared.

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1. How can the Gāyatrī, chief in ritual action, be the means to the knowledge of Brahman? Objection and reply.

To make known the primacy of the Gāyatrī, Śaṅkarācārya said that it plays the chief part by three points, the Gāyatrī being the supreme means of knowing the Supreme Brahman, who is beyond ordinary perception. But here another doubt arises. The scriptural descriptions may be true that the Gāyatrī is the support of all the metres that form part of the sacrifice, and that all other metres grew by resting on it. But there is room for the question: merely because it is chief in the sacrifice, which is predominantly ritual action, how can the Gāyatrī also be a means to knowledge of Brahman? Yet the Śrutis themselves declare that the Gāyatrī is of the nature of Brahman, and that knowledge of Brahman is not possible by any means other than Brahman. All the metres useful to the sacrifice, which reflects the principle of Brahman, are indispensable to it; so what is this greatness of the Gāyatrī alone? The answer is that all the other metres cause only impermanent wealth, whereas the Gāyatrī alone can bestow wealth that is eternal and of the nature of Brahman. The greatness of the Gāyatrī is described in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa thus: एतद्ध वै यजमानस्माध्यात्मानमिति.... (*etadda vai yajamānasmādhyātmānamiti....*). And as to which metre should be resorted to at the time of reciting the Praüga-śastra:

गायत्रं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुस्तेजो वै ब्रह्मवर्चसं गायत्री तेजस्वी ब्रह्मवर्चसी भवतीति । औष्ठिहं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुरायुर्वा उष्णिगायुष्मान्भवतीति । आनुष्टुभं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुः क्षत्रं ना अनुष्टुप्क्षत्रस्याप्ता इति । बार्हतं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुः श्रीर्वै बृहती श्री- मान्यवतीति । पाङ्क्तं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुरन्नं वै पंक्तिरन्नवान्भवतीति । त्रैष्टुभं प्रउगं कुर्याद्वीर्यं वै त्रिष्टुब्बीर्यवान्भवतीति । जागतं प्रउगं कुर्यादित्याहुर्जागता वै पशवः पशुमान्भवतीति । तदु गायत्रमेव कुर्यादब्रह्म वै गायत्री ब्रह्मैतदहर्ब्रह्मणैव तद्ब्रह्म प्रतिपद्यते ॥ (*gāyatraṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhustejo vai brahmavarcasaṃ gāyatrī tejasvī brahmavarcasī bhavatīti | auṣṭhihaṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhurāyurvā uṣṇigāyuṣmānbhavatīti | ānuṣṭubhaṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhuḥ kṣatraṃ nā anuṣṭupkṣatrasyāptā iti | bārhataṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhuḥ śrīrvai bṛhatī śrī- mānyavatīti | pāṅkaṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhurannaṃ vai paṃktirannavānbhavatīti | traiṣṭubhaṃ praugaṃ kuryādvīryaṃ vai triṣṭubbīryavānbhavatīti | jāgataṃ praugaṃ kuryādityāhurjāgatā vai paśavaḥ paśumānbhavatīti | tadu gāyatrameva kuryādabrahma vai gāyatrī brahmaitadaharbrahmaṇaiva tadbrahma pratipadyate ||*) (Ai. Ā. 1-1-3)

If the Praüga-śastra is in the Gāyatrī metre, which is full of splendour and endowed with brahmavarcas, then the man who performs the sacrifice reciting it also becomes splendid and endowed with brahmavarcas; this is the view of some. Another view is that if the Praüga-śastra made of the Uṣṇik, which is life-giving, is recited, the sacrificer obtains long life. Some say that if it is made of the Anuṣṭup, which is full of vigour, the sacrificer becomes vigorous. Others say that by reciting the Praüga made of the Bṛhatī, which is wealth, the sacrificer becomes endowed with wealth. One tradition says that if it is made of the Paṅkti, which is food, and is recited, the sacrificer becomes possessed of the wealth of food. Another tradition says that the Triṣṭup, which is strength, makes it give strength. Still others hold that if the śastra made of the Jagatī, which is wealth in cattle, is recited, the sacrificer obtains wealth in cattle. But wealth in food and the like is all impermanent riches. It is beyond dispute that the eternal wealth of the knowledge of Brahman is obtained only by reciting the Praüga made of the Gāyatrī, which is of the nature of Brahman. Therefore the conclusion is that the Gāyatrī itself is the direct means to the knowledge of Brahman, and no other metre can be.

तदु माधुच्छंदसं (*tadu mādhucchaṃdasaṃ*). It is said that this Praüga made of the Gāyatrī should be made of Madhucchandas. But what is Madhucchandas here? What is the reason for this name? What is the close connection between the Gāyatrī and Madhucchandas? This will be explained later. As stated in the Aitareya Āraṇyaka, it is recited again in many Śruti passages that the Gāyatrī is of the nature of Brahman and that this is the means to knowledge of Brahman.

1. Since the sacrifice, which consists of ritual action, is itself of the nature of Brahman, the above objection has no room.

Even with these Śruti proofs, another question arises here. If knowledge alone were chief here, and one fixed one's aim on knowledge of Brahman through meditation, samādhi and austerity, then one could say that the Gāyatrī is the chief means to knowledge of Brahman. But the primacy of the Gāyatrī is

only in the sacrifice. The sacrifice is predominantly ritual action. So there is also room for the doubt how the Gāyatrī, which is chief in a sacrifice that is predominantly ritual, can directly lead to knowledge. To obtain the answer to this question and to know the chief part of the Gāyatrī in the search for knowledge, one must examine such matters as: what is the true nature of the sacrifice? What is the aim of the sacrifice? Is there opposition between the principle of

Brahman and the principle of the sacrifice? The Saṃhitā and Brāhmaṇa passages that set forth the principle of the sacrifice do not describe the sacrifice merely as a rite yielding worldly fruit. In many places they declare the identity of the sacrifice with Prajāpati, the cause of creation, preservation and dissolution.

संवत्सरो यज्ञः प्रजापति स यावानेव यज्ञो यावत्यस्य मात्रा तावंतमेवैतत्परिगृह्णाति ॥ (*saṃvatsaro yajñaḥ prajāpati sa yāvāneva yajño yāvatyasya mātrā tāvaṃtamevaitatparigṛhṇāti ‖*) (Śa. Brā. 1-2-5-12)

In passages such as this, the identity of Prajāpati with the year, which is of the nature of time, and with the sacrifice in the form of the year, is stated. The construction of such a sacrifice is as follows: तं छंदोभिरभितः परिगृह्य (*taṃ chaṃdobhirabhitaḥ parigṛhya*), that is, one should enclose the sacrificial altar with the metres and establish the fire. In the construction of the sacrifice the metres are the most important of all the materials. This sacrificial altar too is not different from the metres.

तानि वा एतानि सप्तविग्ंशतिर्नक्षत्राणि । छंदाग्ंसि ह त्वेवैषोऽग्निश्चितः । तानि वा एतानि सप्तच्छंदाग्ंसि । (*tāni vā etāni saptavigṃśatirnakṣatrāṇi | chaṃdāgṃsi ha tvevaiṣo 'gniścitaḥ | tāni vā etāni saptacchaṃdāgṃsi |*)

अयं नाव लोक एषोऽग्निश्चितः (*ayaṃ nāva loka eṣo 'gniścitaḥ*)

अंतरिक्षग्ंह त्वैवैषोऽग्निश्चितः । .... द्यौर्हत्वेवेषोऽग्निश्चितः । .... आदित्यो ह त्वैवैषोऽग्निश्चितः । (*aṃtarikṣagṃha tvaivaiṣo 'gniścitaḥ | .... dyaurhatveveṣo 'gniścitaḥ | .... ādityo ha tvaivaiṣo 'gniścitaḥ |*)

This sacrificial altar is the terrestrial world, this is the atmosphere, this is the heavenly world, this is Āditya. Three hundred and sixty directions and intermediate directions surround Āditya. The three hundred and sixty Yajuṣmatī bricks are the three hundred and sixty rays of Āditya. The Sūdadohas are the special principles lying between the rays of Āditya and the directions; these are the seven metres.

सर्वाणि ह त्त्वेव भूतानि । सर्वे देवा एषोऽग्निश्चित आपो वै सर्वे देवाः सर्वाणि भूतानि ता हैता आप एवैषोऽग्निश्चितस्तस्य नाव्या एव परिश्रितः .... आत्मायमेव स योऽयं हिरण्मयःपुरुषः । (*sarvāṇi ha ttveva bhūtāni | sarve devā eṣo 'gniścita āpo vai sarve devāḥ sarvāṇi bhūtāni tā haitā āpa evaiṣo 'gniścitastasya nāvyā eva pariśritaḥ .... ātmāyameva sa yo 'yaṃ hiraṇmayaḥpuruṣaḥ |*) (Śa. Brā. 10-5-4-1 to 15)

Just as around Āditya the boats in the form of the three hundred and sixty rays surround him, so around this altar the gods, men and others in the form of the Yajuṣmatīs surround it. The body of this altar is Āditya

...the Golden Person who dwells within the sun. How attractive and how weighty is the nature of this Golden Person! It is said:

तस्यैते प्रतिष्ठे । रुक्ष्मश्च पुष्करसर्णं चापश्चादित्यमंडलं .... ताविंद्राग्नी द्वे स्वयमातृण्णे इयं चांतरिक्षं च .... विश्वज्योतिष एता देवता अग्निर्वायुरादित्य एता ह्येव देवताः .... आत्मा स एषः सर्वासामपां मध्ये स एष सर्वैः कामैः संपन्नः .... ॥ (*tasyaite pratiṣṭhe | rukṣmaśca puṣkarasarṇaṃ cāpaścādityamaṃḍalaṃ .... tāviṃdrāgnī dve svayamātṛṇṇe iyaṃ cāṃtarikṣaṃ ca .... viśvajyotiṣa etā devatā agnirvāyurāditya etā hyeva devatāḥ .... ātmā sa eṣaḥ sarvāsāmapāṃ madhyè sa eṣa sarvaiḥ kāmaiḥ saṃpannaḥ .... ‖*)

The golden vessel and the lotus leaf are the two feet of this Golden Person who dwells within the sun. The two ladles on the sacrificial altar are his arms. These are Candra and Agni.[?272]. The bricks in the form of the Viśvajyotis are all the deities. Their number is three, and these three reflect Agni, Vāyu and Āditya. The body of this altar is the end of everything. This Golden Person, who has the form of the altar and dwells within the sun, has obtained all desires, and therefore is free from desire and perfectly content.

Thus this principle of sacrifice teaches the unity of the universe, and that the ground of this unity is the principle called Parabrahman. What the Upaniṣads and the like call Parabrahman, the Saṃhitās and Brāhmaṇas call Prajāpati; and they speak of the identity of sacrifice and Prajāpati. The creation of the universe is the fruit of Prajāpati's sacrificial austerity. Prajāpati, the cause of the world, existing before creation and without a second, had to offer himself as the oblation if he was to perform the sacrifice that is the means of creation. By such statements as य आत्मदा बलदा (*ya ātmadā baladā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-121-2) it is described how Prajāpati carried out creation, whose command all the gods and others obey, and whose shadows are death and immortality. The supreme purpose of the sacrifice is thus declared: that we too should worship that Prajāpati, the cause of the universe, by performing sacrificial rites.

The faith to be placed in the principle of sacrifice is not blind faith. This faith must have the power to grasp the spiritual principle. It shows the relation between the sacrifice, the navel of the world, and the principle of Brahman. The sacrificer whose faith rests on spiritual knowledge recognises the identity between himself and the sacrifice. He knows that all the worldly activity of Parabrahman in the form of Prajāpati is contained in this principle of sacrifice, and that he too takes a share in that wheel of the universe. For this realisation meditation and the vision of the inner eye are absolutely necessary:

पश्यन् मन्ये मनसा चक्षसा तान् य इमं यज्ञमयजंत पूर्वे ॥ (*paśyan manye manasā cakṣasā tān ya imaṃ yajñamayajaṃta pūrve ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-130-6)

"With the help of the inner eye in the form of meditation I know and praise the gods and seers who knew the principle of sacrifice, the root of this worldly activity." Thus the necessity of meditation is shown.

This purpose of sacrifice is declared in the sūkta addressed to the deity Savitṛ, in which one prays: whose Bhargas we desire to know, whose nature as the great light we wish to know, "grant us the meditative intellect" — धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् (*dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt*).

युंजते मन उत युंजते धियो विप्रा विप्रस्य बृहतो विपश्चितः । वि होत्रा दधे वयुनाविदेक इन्मही देवस्य सवितुः परिष्टुतिः ॥ (*yuṃjate mana uta yuṃjate dhiyo viprā viprasya bṛhato vipaścitaḥ | vi hotrā dadhe vayunāvideka inmahī devasya savituḥ pariṣṭutiḥ ‖*) (Ma. Saṃ. 5-81-1)[?273]

This shows the necessity of meditation: the learned priests engaged in sacrificial work concentrate their minds and worship Savitṛ by meditation in the form of yoga. Knowing the divine nature of Savitṛ through this meditation is thus the supreme purpose of the sacrifice.

In the present mantra तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*) the importance of the prayer "grant the dhī" is explained, and this matter will be explained again when the right meaning of the word dhī is examined.

Just as the principle of sacrifice is described as the thread of the universe by such statements as यो यज्ञो विश्वतस्तंतुभिस्तत एकशतं (*yo yajño viśvatastaṃtubhistata ekaśataṃ*), so too the Gāyatrī holds a primary place in carrying out sacrifice. By गायत्री वा इदं सर्वं भूतं यदिदं किंच (*gāyatrī vā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ yadidaṃ kiṃca*), that all beings, moving and unmoving, are of the nature of Gāyatrī, the universal pervasion of Gāyatrī and its having merged the whole world into itself is shown.

13. Discussion whether Gāyatrī is merely a means to the knowledge of Brahman or the attainable object in the form of knowledge.

Now, the distinctive character of Gāyatrī as a metre is described in अथातः शिरः । तद्गायत्रीषु भवत्यग्रं वै छंदसां गायत्री । (*athātaḥ śiraḥ | tadgāyatrīṣu bhavatyagraṃ vai chaṃdasāṃ gāyatrī |*) (Ai. Ā. 1-4-1) and so on. For carrying out sacrifices and the like, too, Gāyatrī in the form of a metre holds a most useful primacy. A metre can only be a means for the search after the principle; it cannot itself be the object sought. The doubt therefore arises whether Gāyatrī, which has the form of a metre, can be of the nature of the principle that reflects and teaches the Parabrahman principle, and whether that is possible.

Such a doubt is anticipated in the Brahma-sūtra as well; an answer is given to it and the conclusion is upheld that Gāyatrī is the Parabrahman principle itself and not something different. Since that discussion also establishes the principle by taking Vedic sentences as authority, it may be examined here too.

अपि यदुक्तं पूर्वस्मिन्नपि वाक्ये न ब्रह्म अभिहितमस्ति । गायत्री वा इदं सर्वं भूतं यदिदं किंच, इति गायत्राख्यस्य छंदसोऽभिहित्वात् इति तत् परिहर्तव्यं । कथं पुनः छंदोऽभिधानात् न ब्रह्म अभिहितं इति शक्यते वक्तुं । यावता तावानस्य महिमा इत्येतस्यां ऋचि चतुष्पाद् ब्रह्म दर्शित्वं । नैतदस्ति । गायत्री वा इदं सर्वं इति गायत्रीं उपक्रम्य तामेव भूतपृथिवीशरीरहृदयवाक्प्रभेदैर्वाख्याय । सैषा चतुःप्पदा षड्विधा गायत्री तदेतदृचाभ्यनूक्तं तावानस्य महिमा इति तस्यामेव व्याख्यातरूपायां गायत्रां उदाहृतो मंत्रः कथं अकस्मात् ब्रह्म चतुष्पात् अभिदध्यात् । योऽपि यद्वैतद्ब्रह्मा इति ब्रह्मशब्दः सोऽपि छंदसः प्रकृतत्वात् छंदोविषय एव .... तस्मात् छंदोऽभिधानात् न ब्रह्मणः

प्रकृतत्वं ॥ (*api yaduktaṃ pūrvasminnapi vākye na brahma abhihitamasti | gāyatrī vā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ yadidaṃ kiṃca, iti gāyatrākhyasya chaṃdaso 'bhihitvāt iti tat parihartavyaṃ | kathaṃ punaḥ chaṃdo 'bhidhānāt na brahma abhihitaṃ iti śakyate vaktuṃ | yāvatā tāvānasya mahimā ityetasyāṃ ṛci catuṣpād brahma darśitvaṃ | naitadasti | gāyatrī vā idaṃ sarvaṃ iti gāyatrīṃ upakramya tāmeva bhūtapṛthivīśarīrahṛdayavākprabhedairvākhyāya | saiṣā catuḥppadā ṣaḍvidhā gāyatrī tadetadṛcābhyanūktaṃ tāvānasya mahimā iti tasyāmeva vyākhyātarūpāyāṃ gāyatrāṃ udāhṛto maṃtraḥ kathaṃ akasmāt brahma catuṣpāt abhidadhyāt | yo 'pi yadvaitadbrahmā iti brahmaśabdaḥ so 'pi chaṃdasaḥ prakṛtatvāt chaṃdoviṣaya eva .... tasmāt chaṃdo 'bhidhānāt na brahmaṇaḥ prakṛtatvaṃ* ‖) (Brahma-sūtra, Śā. Bhā. 1-1-25)[?274]

Everything in the world, all beings movable and immovable, is Gāyatrī (Chā. U. 3-12-1); the objector's view is that in describing the nature of Gāyatrī this speaks only of the Gāyatrī in the form of a metre and not of a principle pointing to Parabrahman. To refute this, the siddhāntin points out that in the same Chāndogya Upaniṣad the mantra एतावानस्य महिमा (*etāvānasya mahimā*) ("such is its greatness, so boundless") (Chā. U. 3-12-6) declares the nature of Brahman with four feet. Therefore the word Gāyatrī here means the Parabrahman thing, not merely Gāyatrī as a metre. Against this the objector devises another meaning and explains that sentence thus: having begun with गायत्रि वा इदं सर्वं भूतं (*gāyatri vā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ*), the text divides that same Gāyatrī into intermediate divisions — beings, earth, body, heart, speech, breath — saying that it has four feet and is of six kinds; and this is what the Ṛk-mantra describes as एतावानस्य महिमा (*etāvānasya mahimā*). How can such a description of a metre point to Brahman with four feet? Since the metre alone is the topic in hand, the matter of the metre is what is spoken; there is no mention of Parabrahman. So the objector defends his view. The siddhāntin's answer runs as follows:

नैष दोषः । तथा चेतोऽर्पणनिगदात् । तथा गायत्राख्यच्छंदोद्वारेण तदनुगते ब्रह्मणि चेतसः अर्पणं चित्तसमाधानं अनेन ब्राह्मणवाक्येन निगद्यते । गायत्रि वा इदं सर्वं इति । न हि अक्षरसंनिवेशमात्राया गायत्राः सर्वात्मकत्वं संभवति । तस्मात् यत् गायत्राख्यविकारे अनुगतं

जगत्कारणं ब्रह्म तदिह सर्वं इत्युच्यते ... . तस्मात् अस्ति छंदोऽभिधानेऽपि पूर्वस्मिन् वाक्ये चतुष्पात् ब्रह्म निर्दिष्टं । तदेव ज्योतिर्वाक्येऽपि परामृश्यते उपासनानंतरविधानाय ॥ (*naiṣa doṣaḥ | tathā ceto 'rpaṇanigadāt | tathā gāyatrākhyacchaṃdodvāreṇa tadanugate brahmaṇi cetasaḥ arpaṇaṃ cittasamādhānaṃ anena brāhmaṇavākyena nigadyate | gāyatri vā idaṃ sarvaṃ iti | na hi akṣarasaṃniveśamātrāyā gāyatrāḥ sarvātmakatvaṃ saṃbhavati | tasmāt yat gāyatrākhyavikāre anugataṃ jagatkāraṇaṃ brahma tadiha sarvaṃ ityucyate ... . tasmāt asti chaṃdo 'bhidhāne 'pi pūrvasmin vākye catuṣpāt brahma nirdiṣṭaṃ | tadeva jyotirvākye 'pi parāmṛśyate upāsanānaṃtaravidhānāya* ‖) (Śa. Bhā. Bra. Sū. 1-1.-5)[?275]

The objector's view is not consistent. For in the present context it is said that one should place the mind on the supreme thing and meditate; so, through the metre called Gāyatrī, the mind is to be placed on the Brahman that pervades it, and this is said by the mantra sentence गायत्रि वा इदं सर्वं (*gāyatri vā idaṃ sarvaṃ*).[?276]. To say that Gāyatrī, which is merely an arrangement of syllables and has the form of a metre, is of the nature of everything would be inconsistent. Therefore it can be said decisively that the thing indicated is Parabrahman itself, existing in the form of the effect called Gāyatrī and being the cause of the whole world. That the cause is not different from the effect is said in the sūtra तदनन्यत्वमारंभणशब्दादिभ्यः (*tadananyatvamāraṃbhaṇaśabdādibhyaḥ*) (2-1-14).

In other Śrutis too it is said that the Parabrahman principle, the cause, should be worshipped through the effect[?277]. (Ai. Ā. 3-2-3)

सर्वेषु भूतेष्वेतमेव ब्रह्मेत्याचक्षते ! स एष संवत्सरसमानश्च क्षुर्मयः शोत्रमयश्चंदोमयो मनोमयो वाङ्मय आत्मा स य एवमेतं .... शंसति ॥ (*sarveṣu bhūteṣvetameva brahmetyācakṣate ! sa eṣa saṃvatsarasamānaśca kṣurmayaḥ śotramayaścaṃdomayo manomayo vāṅmaya ātmā sa ya evametaṃ .... śaṃsati* ‖) (Ai. Ā. 3-2-3)[?278]

The cause-thing that has transformed itself into many forms as effects — eye, ear, metre and so on — is Parabrahman. These Śruti sentences teach the above meaning: that this very Parabrahman thing is to be worshipped in forms such as the metre.

Therefore, although in some places the word Gāyatrī clearly gives the meaning "metre", there is no doubt that the Upaniṣad sentence गायत्री वा इदग्ं सर्वं (*gāyatrī vā idagṃ sarvaṃ*) points to the Parabrahman thing itself. Even though it is counted as a metre, just as Parabrahman, who is supernatural, beyond ordinary worldly perception and the cause, reveals himself through worldly effect-things, so the Gāyatrī principle is described as the Parabrahman principle: सैषा चतुष्पदा गायत्री (*saiṣā catuṣpadā gāyatrī*) (Chā. U. 3-12-5)

Of these four feet, the first three reflect the world in the form of the effect, and the fourth (turīya) foot reflects the Brahman principle in the form of the cause. Even when the word Gāyatrī is taken to mean a metre, its purport must be stated as a metre that possesses both these forms. The first three feet are graspable by worldly understanding; the fourth foot is to be realised through yoga and meditation.

14. The spiritual character of metre, and the primacy of Gāyatrī in the search for knowledge.

देवा वै मृत्योर्भिभ्यतस्त्रयीं विद्यां प्राविशंस्ते छंदोभिराच्छादयन्यदेभिराच्छादयन्स्छंदसां छंदस्त्वं ।
(*devā vai mṛtyorbhibhyatastrayīṃ vidyāṃ prāviśaṃste chaṃdobhirācchādayanyadebhirācchādayanschaṃdasāṃ chaṃdastvaṃ* |) (Bhā. U. 1-4-2)[?279]

This sentence states the general characteristic of metre. When the gods, afraid of death, entered the threefold knowledge (trayī), the threefold knowledge concealed them with the metres. The word chandas is derived from the root chad, meaning "cover, conceal". Because they covered them from death, they are called chandas; thus its characteristic is stated. (The root is also used in the sense "to gladden".)

However, even though the metres concealed the gods from the face of death, death discovered that these gods were hidden in the trayī; thus a shortcoming in the power of the metres is also shown. The purport is that in such contexts the metre is worldly and belongs to the world of effects. Although such a metre gives joy, that joy is limited. In speaking of the Gāyatrī metre too, both these forms are described and Gāyatrī is praised. The Upaniṣads praise Gāyatrī by saying that its first three feet reflect the lower principle and the fourth foot reflects the higher principle.

भूमिरंतरिक्षं द्यौरित्यष्टावक्षराणि । अष्टाक्षरं ह वा एकं गायत्रै पदं । एतदु हैवास्या एतदेवं पदं वेद । (*bhūmiraṃtarikṣaṃ dyaurityaṣṭāvakṣarāṇi | aṣṭākṣaraṃ ha vā ekaṃ gāyatrai padaṃ | etadu haivāsyā etadevaṃ padaṃ veda |*) (Bṛ. U. 5-14-1)

Earth, atmosphere, heaven: these eight syllables are the first foot of Gāyatrī. Thus these three worlds together become one foot of Gāyatrī. One who knows this principle obtains the wealth of these three worlds.

यजो यजूग्ंषि, सामानि इत्यष्टावक्षराणि । अष्टाक्षरं ह ना एकं गायत्रै पदं । एतदु हैवास्या एतत् । स यावतीयं त्रयी विद्या तावद्ध जयति योऽस्या एतदेवं पदं वेद । (*yajo yajūgṃṣi, sāmāni ityaṣṭāvakṣarāṇi | aṣṭākṣaraṃ ha nā ekaṃ gāyatrai padaṃ | etadu haivāsyā etat | sa yāvatīyaṃ trayī vidyā tāvaddha jayati yo 'syā etadevaṃ padaṃ veda |*) (Bṛ. U. 5-14-2)

Ṛcs, Yajus formulas, Sāmans: these eight syllables are the second foot of Gāyatrī. One who knows this principle obtains all the wealth of knowledge to be gained from the trayī, the treasury of knowledge.

प्राणोऽपानो व्यान इत्याष्टावक्षराणि । अष्टाक्षरं ह वा एकं गायत्रैशि पदं । एतदु हैवास्या एतत् । स यावदिदं प्राणि तावद्ध जयति योऽस्या एतदेवं पदं वेद । (*prāṇo 'pāno vyāna ityāṣṭāvakṣarāṇi | aṣṭākṣaraṃ ha vā ekaṃ gāyatraiśi padaṃ | etadu haivāsyā etat | sa yāvadidaṃ prāṇi tāvaddha jayati yo 'syā etadevaṃ padaṃ veda* |) (Bṛ. U. 5-4-3)[?280]

The three principles prāṇa, apāna and vyāna are the third foot of Gāyatrī, which consists of eight syllables. One who knows this principle obtains all the wealth of power of the whole class of living beings. The sun, shining with his own radiance and visible to the whole world, is the fourth foot of Gāyatrī. Although he has a nature beyond worldly perception, the sun takes a form open to perception and appears to all; hence the epithet दर्शतं (*darśataṃ*) here. Because he shines in the excellent atmosphere, surpassing all the worlds full of darkness, there is the epithet परोरजाः (*parorajāḥ*). One who knows the nature of this fourth foot becomes radiant and endowed with Brahmanic splendour.

सैषा गायत्र्येतस्मिंस्तुरीये दर्शते पदे परोरजसि प्रतिष्ठिता । तद्वै तत्सत्ये प्रतिष्ठितं । चक्षुर्वै सत्यं । चक्षुर्हि वै सत्यं .... तस्मादाहुर्बलं सत्यादोगीय इति । एवं वैषा गायत्र्यध्यात्मं प्रतिष्ठिता । सा हैषा गयांस्तत्रे । प्राणा वै गयाः तत्पाणांस्तत्रे तद्यद्धयांस्तत्रे तस्माद्दायत्री नाम । स यामेवामुं सावित्रिमन्वाह । एवैष सा । स यस्मा अन्वाह तस्य प्राणास्त्रायंते ॥ (*saiṣā gāyatryetasmiṃsturīye darśate pade parorajasi pratiṣṭhitā | tadvai tatsatye pratiṣṭhitaṃ | cakṣurvai satyaṃ | cakṣurhi vai satyaṃ .... tasmādāhurbalaṃ satyādogīya iti | evaṃ vaiṣā gāyatryadhyātmaṃ pratiṣṭhitā | sā haiṣā gayāṃstatre | prāṇā vai gayāḥ tatpāṇāṃstatre tadyaddhayāṃstatre tasmāddāyatrī nāma | sa yāmevāmuṃ sāvitrimanvāha | evaiṣa sā | sa yasmā anvāha tasya prāṇāstrāyaṃte ‖*)

On this fourth (turīya) foot, described as parorajas and darśata, Gāyatrī is established. That is the world of truth. Therefore Gāyatrī is established on truth. The eye is truth. How? When one man says "I saw" and another says "I heard" and they dispute, the word of the one who saw carries greater authority.

That truth rests on strength. Strength is the vital breath (prāṇa). Therefore those who know say that strength has more substance than truth. The senses of the body are the *gayas*. The breath guards these *gayas*, and for that reason the name is Gāyatrī. This Gāyatrī is itself present in the body in the form of the chief vital breath. It is also called Sāvitrī, the verse the teacher gives to the pupil as instruction. It guards the vital breaths of whoever receives this instruction.

तां हैतमेकेसावित्रिमनुष्टुभमन्वाहुः । वागनुष्टुप् । तद्वाचमनुब्रूम इति । न तथा कुर्यात् । गायत्रीमेव सावित्रिमनुब्रूयात् । यदि ह वा अप्येवंविद्बह्विव प्रतिगृह्णाति न हैव तद्दायत्रा एकंचन पदं प्रति । (*tāṃ haitameke sāvitrimanuṣṭubhamanvāhuḥ | vāganuṣṭup | tadvācamanubrūma iti | na tathā kuryāt | gāyatrīmeva sāvitrimanubrūyāt | yadi ha vā apyevaṃvidbahviva pratigṛhṇāti na haiva taddāyatrā ekaṃcana padaṃ prati |*) (Chā. U. 5-14-5)

Speech (vāc) is in the form of the Anuṣṭubh, and speech is also of the form of the Gāyatrī. For this reason some teachers instruct the Sāvitrī in the form of the Anuṣṭubh. That is not right. Only the Sāvitrī in the form of the Gāyatrī should be taught. A man who knows this truth may accept a very abundant gift, and yet it does not equal even one foot of the Gāyatrī.

स य इमांस्त्रीन्लोकान्पूर्णान् प्रतिगृह्णीयात्, सोऽस्या एतत्पथमं पदमाप्नुयात् । अथ यावतीयं त्रयी विद्या यस्तावत्पतिगृह्णीयात् सोऽस्याएतद्वितीयं पदमाप्नुयात् अथ यावदिदं प्राणि यस्तावत्पतिगृह्णीयात् सोऽस्या एतत्तृतीयं पदमाप्नुयात् अथास्या एतदेव तुरीयं दर्शतं पदं परोरजा य एष तपति । नैव केनच नाप्यं कुत उ एतावत्पतिगृह्णीयात् । (*sa ya imāṃstrīnlokānpūrṇān pratigṛhṇīyāt, so 'syā etatpathamaṃ padamāpnuyāt | atha yāvatīyaṃ trayī vidyā yastāvatpatigṛhṇīyāt so 'syāetadvitīyaṃ padamāpnuyāt atha yāvadidaṃ prāṇi yastāvatpatigṛhṇīyāt so 'syā etattṛtīyaṃ padamāpnuyāt athāsyā etadeva turīyaṃ darśataṃ padaṃ parorajā ya eṣa tapati | naiva kenaca nāpyaṃ kuta u etāvatpatigṛhṇīyāt* |) (Bhā. U. 5-19-6)[?281]

One who accepts only these three worlds, full of wealth, obtains only the first foot of the Gāyatrī. One who accepts only the threefold Veda, the treasure of knowledge, obtains the second foot as well. One who accepts only the whole creation of living beings obtains the third foot as his reward. But no wealth in the world can equal the reward that falls to the man who has realised the fourth foot, the visible one, whose nature is "beyond the dust". Therefore the Gāyatrī is to be worshipped in this manner (Śaṅkara's commentary). The meaning is that the full form of the Gāyatrī is to be worshipped in the form of meditation.

एवं हैवैवं विद्यद्यपि बह्विव पापं कुरुते सर्वमेव तत्संप्साय शुद्धः पूतोऽजरोऽमृतः संभवति । (*evaṃ haivaivaṃ vidyadyapi bahviva pāpaṃ kurute sarvameva tatsaṃpsāya śuddhaḥ pūto 'jaro 'mṛtaḥ saṃbhavati* |) (Bhā. U. 5-14-8)[?282]

Even if one who knows the principle of the Gāyatrī in full should by chance commit sinful acts, he burns all of them and becomes pure, ageless and immortal. Because Agni is the mouth of the Gāyatrī

तस्या अग्नीरेव मुखं (*tasyā agnīreva mukhaṃ*): the meaning is that one who knows the principle of the Gāyatrī in full obtains the power of Agni, who burns up sins. Thus the full nature of the Gāyatrī, both manifest and unmanifest, is explained in the above sentences of the

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad. In the Chāndogya Upaniṣad too the all-pervading nature of the Gāyatrī is described in the sentences quoted below.

1. How can a metre with a fixed group of syllables be of the form of the all-pervading Brahman?

गायत्री वा इदं सर्वं भूतं यदिदं किंच वाग्वै गायत्री वाग्वा इदं सर्वं भूतं गायति त्रायते च । (*gāyatrī vā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ yadidaṃ kiṃca vāgvai gāyatrī vāgvā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ gāyati trāyate ca |*) (Chā. U. 3-12-1)

छंदोमात्रायाः सर्वभूतत्वमनुपपन्नं इति गायत्रीकारणं वाचं शब्दरूपमापादयति गायत्री वाग्वै गायत्रीति ॥ (*chaṃdomātrāyāḥ sarvabhūtatvamanupapannaṃ iti gāyatrīkāraṇaṃ vācaṃ śabdarūpamāpādayati gāyatrī vāgvai gāyatrīti ‖*) (Śa. Bhā.)[?283]

In describing the all-pervading nature of the Gāyatrī, saying that all beings, sentient and insentient, are the Gāyatrī, the text foresees that a doubt may arise, and so it states the identity of speech with the Gāyatrī: वाग्वै गायत्रि (*vāgvai gāyatri*). A question arises here. The doubt is how a metre that is merely a collection of syllables can be all-pervading and be all beings. The answer is to declare that speech itself is the Gāyatrī. What then is the nature and power of speech? Its power is to illuminate the whole business of the universe completely and to be of the nature of the universe. Since the existence of the whole world is made manifest by it, and since the protection and carrying on of the whole world belong to speech, speech pervades the whole world and is identical with it. That this goddess of speech is called by the name Gāyatrī explains one aspect of the Gāyatrī. Moreover,

या वै सा गायत्रीयं वाव सा येयं पृथिव्यस्यां हीदं सर्वं भूतं प्रतिष्ठितमेतामेव नातिशीयते । (*yā vai sā gāyatrīyaṃ vāva sā yeyaṃ pṛthivyasyāṃ hīdaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ pratiṣṭhitametāmeva nātiśīyate |*) (A. U. 3-17-2) (Chā. U. 3-12-2)[?284]

Just as the Gāyatrī was called speech because it sings (gāyati) and protects the existence of all beings, so here the Gāyatrī is called the earth, since it has the nature and power of the earth. All beings rest on the earth and are established here. They do not cross this limit. Therefore the Gāyatrī and the earth are identical.

1. Two ways of worshipping the Gāyatrī.

Identity with the outer world.

A man who worships may worship the Gāyatrī from two points of view. First, through meditation on the Gāyatrī he may know the whole outer world, earth, atmosphere and the rest, and understand that all of it is a particular manifestation of the Gāyatrī's glory. Or, from the spiritual point of view, he may know the particular principles within a man's body, and know that these too are manifestations of the Gāyatrī's glory. The sentences of the Upaniṣad describe this matter also.

या वै सा पृथिवीयं वाव सा यदिदमस्मान्पुरुषे शरीरमस्मिन् हीमे प्राणाः प्रतिष्ठिता एतदेव नातिशीयंते ॥ (*yā vai sā pṛthivīyaṃ vāva sā yadidamasmānpuruṣe śarīramasmin hīme prāṇāḥ pratiṣṭhitā etadeva nātiśīyaṃte ||*) (Chā. U. 3-12-3)

The principle we call the earth is itself, in the form of the aggregate of effect and cause, the body of the man. Just as all beings are established on the earth, so all the chief vital breaths too are established in this body. Just as all beings stay in their fixed condition without passing beyond the earth, so these chief vital breaths too remain within their fixed limit without passing beyond the order of the body.

यद्वै तत्पुरुषे शरीरमिदं वाव तद्यदिदमस्मिन्नंतः पुरुषे हृदयमस्मिन्हीमे प्राणाः प्रतिष्ठिता एतदेव नातिशीयंते ॥ (*yadvai tatpuruṣe śarīramidaṃ vāva tadyadidamasminnaṃtaḥ puruṣe hṛdayamasminhīme prāṇāḥ pratiṣṭhitā etadeva nātiśīyaṃte ||*) (Chā. U. 3-12-4)

The bodily principle that we call the Gāyatrī is the lotus of the heart of the man. It is here that the principle of the chief vital breath is established. The principle of breath does not pass beyond this limit.

सैषा चतुष्पदा पद्विधा गायत्री तदेतदृचाभ्यनूक्तं । (*saiṣā catuṣpadā padvidhā gāyatrī tadetadṛcābhyanūktaṃ |*)

This Gāyatrī, which has four feet and is of six kinds, is described in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā in this way:

एतानानस्य महिमातो ज्यायाश्च पूरुषः । पादोऽस्य विश्वा भूतानि त्रिपादस्यामृतं दिवि ॥ (*etānānasya mahimāto jyāyāśca pūruṣaḥ | pādo 'sya viśvā bhūtāni tripādasyāmṛtaṃ divi* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-90-3)[?285]

This is a description of the greatness of the Supreme Person. "Etāvān" means: all this universe, of the nature of the three times and having the forms of the sentient and the insentient, is the manifestation of this Supreme Person. But the Person's own greatness exceeds all this. The whole universe is only one quarter of this Person. All the remaining parts stay as radiance in his own indestructible, luminous, supra-natural nature.

Description of identity with the inner spiritual principle.

In this description the identity of the Supreme Person with the Gāyatrī is stated. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya explains this:

तावानस्य गायत्राख्यस्य ब्रह्मणः समस्तस्य महिमा विभूतिविस्तारः ॥ (*tāvānasya gāyatrākhyasya brahmaṇaḥ samastasya mahimā vibhūtivistāraḥ ‖*)

He says that the nature and the special glory of the Supreme Brahman, known as the Gāyatrī, are described by these sentences, and he explains the words *pāda* and *tripāt* as set out above.

Although the Upaniṣadic sentences quoted above state the identity of the Gāyatrī with the Supreme Brahman, there are differences in some respects between what is described in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad and what is praised in the Chāndogya. One must first note that difference; then examine which principles of the Supreme Reality the descriptions of the three feet, the fourth foot and so on convey; and, if the deity Savitṛ praised in the present mantra तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं (*tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ*) is itself the Supreme Principle, how these epithets are used in the Saṃhitā and elsewhere.

All beings, the threefold knowledge, the earth, the body, the heart and the chief vital breath are one foot of the Gāyatrī whose nature is the Supreme Reality, or of the Supreme Reality whose nature is the Gāyatrī. This foot is *mūrta*, that is, perceptible to ordinary worldly perception. According to the Chāndogya description, the other three feet also have an ageless, supra-natural form, situated in the atmosphere, as is said in त्रिपादूर्ध्वमुदैत् (*tripādūrdhvamudait*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-90-3). The explanation of the Bṛhadāraṇyaka is somewhat different. The first three feet are of the nature of the three worlds, of the form of speech beginning with the Ṛk, and of the form of prāṇa, apāna and vyāna. These have a concrete (*mūrta*) form. The Bṛhadāraṇyaka description is that the fourth (turīya) foot lies beyond ordinary perception, is situated in the atmosphere and is contained within the sun

. In these two explanations there is not much difference in principle. Therefore it cannot be said that one contradicts the other. In the present context one must examine how other Śruti passages describe the nature of the fourth foot of the Brahman whose nature is the Gāyatrī.

1. The nature of the three feet and the fourth foot of the Gāyatrī.

The meaning of the explanation "pādo 'sya viśvā bhūtāni".

In the Māṇḍūkya-kārikā and in the other commentaries connected with it, the word *turīya* has a technical sense. In the description of the spiritual nature of the principle, when the states of a person such as waking are explained,

सर्वग्न् हैतद्ब्रह्मायमात्मा ब्रह्म सोऽयमात्मा चतुष्पात् । (*sarvagn haitadbrahmāyamātmā brahma so 'yamātmā catuṣpāt* |) (Mā. U. 2)[?]
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After stating the identity of the Self with Brahman, the text declares the four states of the Brahman-substance consisting of four feet, or of the Self in the form of Brahman. This Self, who is both the Supreme Brahman and the lower Brahman, denoted by Oṃkāra, has four feet. Their nature is as follows:

1. जागरितस्थानो बहिष्प्रज्ञः (*jāgaritasthāno bahiṣprajñaḥ*): one whose place is the waking state and whose consciousness is directed outward.
2. स्वप्नस्थानोऽंतःप्रज्ञः (*svapnasthāno 'ṃtaḥprajñaḥ*): one whose place is the dream state, the inwardly conscious one.
3. सुषुप्तस्थान एकीभूतः (*suṣuptasthāna ekībhūtaḥ*): the knower (prājña) in the state of deep sleep, dense with knowledge, who sees not even a dream.
4. नांतःप्रज्ञं न बहिष्प्रज्ञं नोभयतः प्रज्ञं .... अदृष्टमव्यवहार्यं .... शांतं शिवमदैतं चतुर्थं मन्यंते स आत्मा स विज्ञेयः ॥ (*nāṃtaḥprajñaṃ na bahiṣprajñaṃ nobhayataḥ prajñaṃ .... adṛṣṭamavyavahāryaṃ .... śāṃtaṃ śivamadaitaṃ caturthaṃ manyaṃte sa ātmā sa vijñeyaḥ ‖*)

The Self who is neither inwardly conscious nor outwardly conscious, who does not fall within ordinary perception, who is peaceful, auspicious, the essence of the one Self-awareness, of non-dual nature, is the Turīya. The meaning is that he transcends the three feet commonly perceived by the world and has a fourth nature. The same Self is praised as एष त आत्मांतराम्यमृतोऽदृष्टो द्रष्टा (*eṣa ta ātmāṃtarāmyamṛto 'dṛṣṭo draṣṭā*)

श्रुतः श्रोता (*śrutaḥ śrotā*) (Bṛ. U. 3-7-23): he is the witness of the whole world but is not visible to the world's sight; he hears everything but does not fall within the world's hearing; and so on. The Turīya state, described as having a fourth foot that transcends the three feet of the world, is well known in the world of philosophical systems (darśana). The same meaning must be stated here too, in describing the nature of the Supreme Brahman whose nature is the Gāyatrī.

When describing a particular principle that is supra-natural and beyond the world, the word *turīya* is seen to be used in the same sense in the Ṛk-Saṃhitā too. For example:

एष स्य भानुरुदियर्ति युज्यते रथः परिज्मा दिवो अस्य सानवि । पृक्षासो आस्मिन्मिथुना अधि त्रयो दृतिस्तुरीयो मधुनो वि रिष्यते ॥ (*eṣa sya bhānurudiyarti yujyate rathaḥ parijmā divo asya sānavi | pṛkṣāso āsminmithunā adhi trayo dṛtisturīyo madhuno vi riṣyate ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-45-1)

This is a description of the course of the sun. It says that the three kinds of food, visible and well known on his chariot, shine, and also the fourth (turīya) food, supra-natural and sweeter than these (known as *madhu* in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka and other texts). Although this fourth food in the form of honey shines with its own radiance, it differs in principle from the first three foods. The meaning is that, just as the radiance of the golden Person within the sun has a splendour greater than the mere radiance of the sun, so the radiance of this food, of the nature of honey, is worthy of praise.

स्वर्भानोरध यदिंद्र माया अवो दिवो वर्तमाना अवाहन् । गूह्ळं सूर्यं तमसापव्रतेन तुरीयेण ब्रह्मणाविंददत्रिः ॥ (*svarbhānoradha yadiṃdra māyā avo divo vartamānā avāhan | gūhlaṃ sūryaṃ tamasāpavratena turīyeṇa brahmaṇāviṃdadatriḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-40-6)

Here it is said that the sage Atri, by four kinds of mantras, destroyed four kinds of darkness and came to know the special powers covered by it. This is a description of the sun's radiance. That is, the sun's form is of one kind from the world's point of view. The radiance that falls on everyone's eye is common to the world. A radiance greater than that is not perceptible to ordinary sight. For it the help of the mantra and a special meditation prompted by it are necessary. In the same way, if the darkness is understood as the ignorance whose form is darkness, or as the darkness whose form is ignorance, then the meaning is clear that the divine radiance of the sun in the Turīya state can be known only through the power of the Turīya mantra. In the same way,

चमूषच्छ्येनः शकुनो विभृत्वा गोविंदुर्द्रप्स आयुधानि बिभ्रत् । अपामूर्मिं सचमानः समुद्रं तुरीयं धाम महिषो विवक्ति ॥ (*camūṣacchyenaḥ śakuno vibhṛtvā goviṃdurdrapsa āyudhāni bibhrat | apāmūrmiṃ sacamānaḥ samudraṃ turīyaṃ dhāma mahiṣo vivakti ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-96-19)

In this mantra there is praise of the world of the Moon. The sense of the mantra is that Soma, who frequents the atmosphere, shone as he resorted to the world of the Moon, which lies even beyond the world of the Sun. This same lunar world is described differently in the Upaniṣads. To show that in the present context it is a supernatural, divine world, Sāyaṇa has explained it as सूरलोकस्योपरि वर्तमाने (*sūralokasyopari vartamāne*). Here too the word तुरीय (*turīya*) points to the divine abode of the Moon and so expresses a special meaning. Thus the word तुरीय (*turīya*) is used in the Ṛksaṃhitā also to denote the supernatural highest reality.

When it is said that this fourth part is beyond the other three parts of the universe, it must not be understood as different from them. The sense is that one single reality pervades the natural universe and is also transcendent to it. How is that? स भूमिं विश्वतो वृत्वात्यतिष्ठद्दशांगुलं (*sa bhūmiṃ viśvato vṛtvātyatiṣṭhaddaśāṃgulaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-90-1): the one Supreme Person-principle, pervading the universe, stood beyond it by the measure of ten fingers. What "ten fingers" means here will be explained later according to context.

1. The Supreme Person's pervasion of the universe and his transcendence of it.

रूपंरूपं प्रतिरूपो बभूव तदस्य रूपं प्रतिचक्षणाय । इंद्रो मायाभिः पुरुरूप ईयते युक्ता ह्यस्य हरयः शता दश ॥ (*rūpaṃrūpaṃ pratirūpo babhūva tadasya rūpaṃ praticakṣaṇāya | iṃdro māyābhiḥ pururūpa īyate yuktā hyasya harayaḥ śatā daśa ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-47-18)

In this mantra the pervasion of the universe is clearly stated. It is a well-known mantra, cited in the Upaniṣads and elsewhere. It is addressed to Indra and describes Indra's great glory. The sense is that Indra himself, assuming the forms of many deities such as Agni, Viṣṇu and Rudra, and the forms of all the natural principles in the universe, pervades the universe as one divine principle in the form of the universe. Sāyaṇa takes this mantra as one that teaches a spiritual principle and has explained it as being the description of the nature of the Supreme Brahman. Here "Indra" means the Supreme Self. That Supreme Self, all-pervading like space and of the nature of eternal bliss, being one, enters all the bodies in the universe according to their respective limiting conditions and attains the variety and division called individual selves. He explains that the Supreme Self, to whom pervasion of the universe and a form transcending the universe belong as equal attributes, is described in this way.

अग्निर्यथैको भुवनं प्रविष्टो रूपंरूपं प्रतिरूपो बभूव । (*agniryathaiko bhuvanaṃ praviṣṭo rūpaṃrūpaṃ pratirūpo babhūva |*)

(९ठ ५-९ (*9ṭha 5-9*))[?287]

In Upaniṣadic mantras of this kind also the pervasion of the universe is described as stated above. वृक्ष इव स्तब्धो दिव तिष्ठत्येकस्तेनेदं पूर्णं पुरुषेण-सर्वं (*vṛkṣa iva stabdho diva tiṣṭhatyekastenedaṃ pūrṇaṃ puruṣeṇa-sarvaṃ*)[?288]: the whole universe is pervaded by the Supreme Person, who, going beyond the limit of the universe and being transcendent to it, stands

immovable, established like a tree. This attribute of pervasion was also described when the nature of the Gāyatrī was described; it was stated above by citing the sentence एतावानस्य महिमातोज्यायांश्च पूरुषः (*etāvānasya mahimātojyāyāṃśca pūruṣaḥ*). The same point is described in the Chāndogya by the sentences cited below.

1. The similarity of outer space and heart-space.

यद्वै तद्ब्रह्मेतिदं नाव तद्योऽयं बहिर्धा पुरुषादाकाशो यो वै स बहिर्धा पुरुषादाकाशः ॥ आयं नाव स योऽयमंतः पुरुष आकाशो यो वै सोऽंतःपुरुष आकाशः अयं नाव स योऽयमंतर्हृदय आकाशस्तदेतत्पूर्णमप्रवृत्तिपूर्णामप्रवर्तिनीं श्रियं लभते य एवं वेद ॥ (*yadvai tadbrahmetidaṃ nāva tadyo 'yaṃ bahirdhā puruṣādākāśo yo vai sa bahirdhā puruṣādākāśaḥ || āyaṃ nāva sa yo 'yamaṃtaḥ puruṣa ākāśo yo vai so 'ṃtaḥpuruṣa ākāśaḥ ayaṃ* *nāva sa yo 'yamaṃtarhṛdaya ākāśastadetatpūrṇamapravṛttipūrṇāmapravartinīṃ śriyaṃ labhate ya evaṃ veda ‖*)

(Chā. U. 3-12-7 to 9)

This Supreme Brahman, praised in the form of the Gāyatrī and having four quarters, is itself the space that pervades the outer world. This very principle of space, pervading the outer world of the person, is also the person's inner principle. This Brahman-principle called Gāyatrī, in the heart-space, is all-pervading and immovable. One who knows this principle obtains the wealth of knowledge, all-pervading, eternal and steady, and happiness. The nature of this Supreme principle in the lotus of the heart is to be worshipped through meditation.

दह्रं विपापं वरमेऽत्मभूतं यत्पुंडरीकं पुरमध्यसग्स्थं । तत्रापि दह्रं गगनं विशोकस्तस्मिन्यदंतस्तदुपासितव्यं ॥ (*dahraṃ vipāpaṃ varame 'tmabhūtaṃ yatpuṃḍarīkaṃ puramadhyasagsthaṃ | tatrāpi dahraṃ gaganaṃ viśokastasminyadaṃtastadupāsitavyaṃ ‖*)

(Tai. U. U. 4-12-3)[?289]

The Brahman-principle described in this mantra is described by the Chāndogya sentence अंतर्हृदयाकाशः (*aṃtarhṛdayākāśaḥ*). Since the Gāyatrī too is described in this way by epithets that establish Brahman, the following matters must be examined. What is meant here by heart-space? What is the lotus of the heart? If the principle of space, which is the support of the Gāyatrī that is both within the lotus of the heart and, at that very time, pervades the whole outer universe—earth, atmosphere and the rest—is the Supreme Brahman, what relation is shown between this principle of space and the Vyāhṛtis beginning with भूः (*bhūḥ*), which are limbs of the Gāyatrī? What is the relation between the Praṇava, which has the Vyāhṛtis as its members, and the Brahman that is of the nature of the Gāyatrī? In what way does the Praṇava become the chief means to the realisation of Brahman? Is the Gāyatrī itself of the nature of the Praṇava? and so on.

Sentences such as अंतर्बहिश्च तत्सर्वं व्याप्य नारायणः स्थितः (*aṃtarbahiśca tatsarvaṃ vyāpya nārāyaṇaḥ sthitaḥ*) teach that the outer principle that pervades all the worlds is the same as the principle within the heart of the person. This one principle is denoted by other names such as Brahman, space and Gāyatrī. In the present context, this pervasion of the inside and the outside is stated exactly also when the three forms Brahman, space and Gāyatrī are described, and it is also made plain that all three are other names of one principle.

एषा गायत्र्यध्यात्मं प्रतिष्ठिता सा हैषा गयांस्तत्रे प्राणा वै गयास्तत्पाणांस्तत्रे तद्यद्गयांस्तत्रे तस्माद्गायत्री नाम स यामेवामूं सावित्रिमन्वाहैवैष सा स यस्मा अन्वाह तस्य प्राणांस्त्रायते ॥ (*eṣā gāyatryadhyātmaṃ pratiṣṭhitā sā haiṣā gayāṃstatre prāṇā vai gayāstatpāṇāṃstatre tadyadgayāṃstatre tasmādgāyatrī nāma sa yāmevāmūṃ sāvitrimanvāhaivaiṣa sā sa yasmā anvāha tasya prāṇāṃstrāyate ‖*)

(Bṛ. U. 5-14-4)

As explained in the sentences cited above, the Gāyatrī-principle that is described by epithets such as परोरजाः (*parorajāḥ*) and that pervades the universe is the very one that, in its spiritual form, lies within the heart; thus the pervasion of the Gāyatrī both within and without is taught. In the same way, describing the nature of space:

यावान् ना अयमाकाशस्तानानेषोऽंतर्हृदय आकाश उभे अस्मिन् द्यावापृथिवी अंतरेव समाहिते उभावग्निश्च वायुश्च सूराचंद्रमसावुभौ विद्युन्नक्षत्राणि यच्चास्केहास्ति यच्च नास्ति सर्वं तदस्मिन् समाहितमिति ॥ (*yāvān nā ayamākāśastānāneṣo 'ṃtarhṛdaya ākāśa ubhe asmin dyāvāpṛthivī aṃtareva samāhite ubhāvagniśca vāyuśca sūrācaṃdramasāvubhau vidyunnakṣatrāṇi yaccāskehāsti yacca nāsti sarvaṃ tadasmin samāhitamiti ‖*)

(Bhā. U. 8-1-3)[?290]

In this Brahman-city, the body, there is a subtle house in the form of a lotus. That is the heart-space. It is the dwelling-place of Brahman. One must search for it and see the Brahman-principle there: यदिदमस्मिन् ब्रह्मपुरे दहरं पुंडरीकं वेश्य दहरोऽस्मिन्नंतराकाशस्तस्मिन्यदंतस्तदन्वेष्टव्यं तद्वाव विजिज्ञासितव्यमिति (*yadidamasmin brahmapure daharaṃ puṃḍarīkaṃ veśya daharo 'sminnaṃtarākāśastasminyadaṃtastadanveṣṭavyaṃ tadvāva vijijñāsitavyamiti*) (Chā. U. 8-1-1). The nature of this subtle inner space, which contains the Brahman-principle that is greater than the cosmic egg, is this: as widely as the outer space spreads, so widely does this heart-space spread. In it both heaven and earth are spread; moreover, wind and fire, moon and sun, lightning and stars, whatever is contained within the body and whatever is not—all is contained in this small space. This heart-space is extremely subtle and free from sin. It is the best dwelling-place. In the form of a lotus, in the middle of the city that is the body, in this subtle heart there is a space still subtler, and the Brahman-principle that is contained in that space is to be worshipped: thus the heart-space is described.

1. The Gāyatrī in the form of speech, and the space that is the source of name-and-form usage.

वाग्वै गायत्री । (*vāgvai gāyatrī* |) वाग्वा इदं सर्वं भूतं गायति त्रायते च । (*vāgvā idaṃ sarvaṃ bhūtaṃ gāyati trāyate ca* |) Because the existence of the whole world is revealed only by speech, and because the protection and maintenance of the whole world belongs to speech, speech itself pervades the whole world and is identical with it. It was stated above that this goddess of speech is called by the name Gāyatrī. In many places it is stated that there is a relation of support and supported between the heart-space explained here and speech, which is of the nature of the Word-Brahman and is denoted by the name Gāyatrī, and therefore also that the two are one. Stating the same relation in the Chāndogya also, it says that space is the support of speech, which is the source of all worldly usage.

आकाशो वै नाम नामरूपयोर्निर्वहिता ते यदंतरा तद्ब्रह्म तदमृतं स आत्मा । (*ākāśo vai nāma nāmarūpayornirvahitā te yadaṃtarā tadbrahma tadamṛtaṃ sa ātmā* |)

(Chā. U. 8-14-1)

Space itself is the cause of the individual division called name and form. He who is within it is the Supreme Brahman, the Supreme Self. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya quoted this sentence in the section on the Daharādhikaraṇa in his Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya and declared the identity of the Supreme Brahman with this small space.

प्रसिद्धेश्व—इतश्च परमेश्वर एव दहरोऽस्मिन्नंतराकाश इत्युच्यते । (*prasiddheśva—itaśca parameśvara eva daharo 'sminnaṃtarākāśa ityucyate* |)[?291] यत्कारणमाकाशशब्दः परमेश्वरे प्रसिद्धः । (*yatkāraṇamākāśaśabdaḥ parameśvare prasiddhaḥ* |) आकाशो वै नाम.... ....स आत्मा सर्वाणि ह वा इमानि भूतान्याकाशादेव समुत्पद्यंते ((*ākāśo vai nāma.... ....sa ātmā sarvāṇi ha vā imāni bhūtānyākāśādeva samutpadyaṃte ()* इत्यादि प्रयोगदर्शनात् ॥ (*ityādi prayogadarśanāt* ‖)

(Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya 1-3-17)

This inner heart-space is well known by the name Supreme Lord. Because space is the cause of the division of name and form, which are the outer manifestations of the Supreme Brahman, and because there are Śruti sentences such as "all these beings arise from space alone" which declare the identity of space with Brahman, the small space is well known in some places as the dwelling-place of Brahman and in others as of the very form of Brahman.

सा इयं शब्दब्रह्मात्मिका वाक् उत्कृष्टे हृदयाकाशे मूलाधारे सहस्राक्षरा अनेकाकारेण व्याप्ता भवति ॥ (*sā iyaṃ śabdabrahmātmikā vāk utkṛṣṭe hṛdayākāśe mūlādhāre sahasrākṣarā anekākāreṇa vyāptā bhavati* ‖)

(Śaṃ. Bhā.)[?292]

This speech, of the form of the Word-Brahman, abiding in the Mūlādhāra, which is excellent and of the form of the heart-space, takes immeasurable shapes and pervades the universe. In such descriptions the identity of the Word-Brahman, called Gāyatrī, with the Brahman that is of the nature of space is stated. The Brahman described in this way is itself of the form of light. What the nature of this light called Brahman is, is described in the Upaniṣads as follows.

1. The light-form of the Supreme Principle.

अथ य एषोऽंतरे हृत्पुष्कर एवाश्रितोऽन्नमत्ति स एषोऽग्निर्दिवि श्रितः सौरः कालाख्योऽदृश्यः सर्वभूतान्यन्नमत्तीति । (*atha ya eṣo 'ṃtare hṛtpuṣkara evāśrito 'nnamatti sa eṣo 'gnirdivi śritaḥ sauraḥ kālākhyo 'dṛśyaḥ sarvabhūtānyannamattīti* |) कः पुष्करः किंमयो वेति। (*kaḥ puṣkaraḥ kiṃmayo veti*|) इदं नाव तत्पुष्करं योऽयमाकाशोऽस्यैमाश्चतस्रो दिशश्चतस्र उपदिशो दलसंस्था आसं । (*idaṃ nāva tatpuṣkaraṃ yo 'yamākāśo 'syèmāścatasro diśaścatasra upadiśo* *dalasaṃsthā āsaṃ* |) अर्वाग्विचरत एतौ प्राणादित्या एता उपासीतोमित्येतदक्षरेण व्याहृतिभिः सावित्रा चेति ॥ (*arvāgvicarata etau prāṇādityā etā upāsītomityetadakṣareṇa vyāhṛtibhiḥ sāvitrā ceti* ‖)

(Maitrupaniṣat 6-2)[?293]

The Person who, abiding in the lotus of the heart, eats food, is the divine light, all-devouring, of the nature of Time, and of the form of the Sun. What is this lotus of the heart? What is its nature? The all-pervading space itself is this lotus of the heart. The four main directions and the four intermediate directions are the petals of this lotus of the form of space. The Self abiding in the lotus and the Sun abiding in space face each other. It is taught that this principle is to be contemplated by the Vyāhṛtis भूः (*bhūḥ*), भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*), स्वः (*svaḥ*), by the syllable Praṇava in the form of ओं (*oṃ*), and by the recitation of the Gāyatrī in the form of the Sāvitrī, तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गोदेवस्य धीमहि (*tatsaviturvareṇyaṃ bhargò devasya dhīmahi*).

The division भूः (*bhūḥ*), भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*), स्वः (*svaḥ*) describes the nature of Brahman, who is of the form of light, and equally the nature of the Praṇava and the Gāyatrī. It is said from the worldly point of view that Brahman is the end to be attained and the Praṇava and Gāyatrī are the means, and from the ordinary standpoint of the division into the object of worship and the means of worship. But the Śruti teaches that in the ultimate sense this end and means are to be understood as one. It must be chiefly noticed that the principle of the form of light can be known only by a means that is itself of the form of light. And this means is of the form of meditation. Therefore it must be examined, as is at present necessary: what is the light-nature of the Supreme Principle, the end; what is the light-nature of the Gāyatrī and the Praṇava, the means; what is the nature of the meditation that knows the Supreme Light; and, तत्त्ववितुः (*tattvavituḥ*)[?294]

whether it can be said that in this one great mantra alone these three forms, end, means and meditation, are indicated.

स त्रेधात्मानं व्याकुरुतादित्यं तृतीयं वायुं तृतीयं स एष प्राणस्त्रेधा विहितः । (*sa tredhātmānaṃ vyākurutādityaṃ tṛtīyaṃ vāyuṃ tṛtīyaṃ sa eṣa prāṇastredhā vihitaḥ* |) तस्य प्राची दिक्किरोऽसौ चासौ चेर्मौ । (*tasya prācī dikkiro 'sau cāsau cermau* |) तस्य प्राची दिक्किरोऽसौ चेर्मौ । (*tasya prācī dikkiro 'sau cermau* |) आधास्य प्रतीची दिक्षुच्छमसौ चासौ च सक्थ्या दक्षिणा चोदीची च पार्श्वे द्यौः पृष्ठमंतरिक्षमुदरमियमुरः (*ādhāsya pratīcī dikṣucchamasau cāsau ca sakthyā dakṣiṇā codīcī ca pārśve dyauḥ pṛṣṭhamaṃtarikṣamudaramiyamuraḥ*) स एषोऽप्सु प्रतिष्ठितो यत्र क्व चैति तदेव प्रतितिष्ठत्येवं विद्वान् । (*sa eṣo 'psu pratiṣṭhito yatra kva caiti tadeva pratitiṣṭhatyevaṃ vidvān* |)

(Bṛ. U. 1-2-3)

This Supreme Brahman, described as the sacrificial horse, took three forms: one became known in the form of earthly fire, another in the form of the Sun, and the third in the form of the wind. It must be said that Prāṇa, whose nature is spiritual, itself has these three states. These three worlds, which contain the lights beginning with Agni, are like the limbs of the horse. The eastern quarter is its head, its forelegs and its flanks. The west is its hind feet and its two hind flanks. The bones on the two sides are the forms of south and north. The back is the heavenly world; the belly is the atmosphere; the chest is the earth. It is established in the waters. One who knows this principle is also firmly established. These three divisions were explained and stated before. In the special subjects of Ṛks such as त्रयः केशिनः ऋतुथा वि चक्षते (*trayaḥ keśinaḥ ṛtuthā vi cakṣate*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 164-44)[?295], the three divisions of the Supreme Light described above are also described. The Supreme Light, which contains these three kinds of light or is itself of their form, is the Supreme Brahman. The golden Person within the Sun is that light itself, which in the Ṛksaṃhitā is described thus:

केश्यंग्निं केशी विषं केशी बिभर्ति रोदसी । केशी विश्वं स्वर्दृशे केशीदं ज्योतिरुच्यते ॥
(*keśyaṃgniṃ keśī viṣaṃ keśī bibharti rodasī | keśī viśvaṃ svardṛśe keśīdaṃ jyotirucyate* ‖)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-136-1)

Keśin, that is, the Sun, radiant and of the nature of rays, bears fire and water. He bears heaven and earth. The whole universe beholds his form made of radiance. The lord of the universe, of such a light-form, has the name Keśin: thus it is described.

यज्योतिरमृतं ब्रह्म यद्योगात्समुपाश्नुते । तज्ज्ञानमभितुष्टाव सूक्तेनाथ बृहस्पतिः ॥ (*yajyotiramṛtaṃ brahma yadyogātsamupāśnute | tajjñānamabhituṣṭāva sūktenātha bṛhaspatiḥ ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 7-109)

Knowledge is the light that reveals the nature of Brahman. Only with its help is direct realisation of Brahman, whose form is light, possible. The Bṛhaddevatā states that Bṛhaspati (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-71) praised that very light.

यत्र ज्योतिरजस्रं यस्मिल्लोकेस्वर्हितं । तस्मिन् मां धेहि पवमानामृते लोकेअक्षित इंद्रायेंदो परि स्रव ॥ (*yatra jyotirajasraṃ yasmilloke svarhitaṃ | tasmin māṃ dhehi pavamānāmṛte loke akṣita iṃdrāyeṃdo pari srava ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-113-7)

In Śruti passages such as this too there is a description of the nature of Brahman as light. The purport of the above passages is that this Brahman, whose form is light, shines in the three worlds, Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ and Svaḥ, in three forms: Agni, Vāyu and Āditya. These three lights are also indicated by other names:

अग्निर्वायुरादित्यः कालो यः प्राणोऽन्नं ब्रह्मारुद्रो मिष्णुरित्येकेऽन्य मभिध्यायंति ...॥ (*agnirvāyurādityaḥ kālo yaḥ prāṇo 'nnaṃ brahmārudro miṣṇurityeke 'nya mabhidhyāyaṃti ...‖*) (Maitrī Upaniṣad 4-5)[?296]

Some worship and indicate the three forms of this supreme light as Agni, Vāyu and Āditya; some as Kāla, Prāṇa and Anna; some as Brahmā, Rudra and Viṣṇu. If one asks which of these is the best and truly real, the praise in the Maitrī Upaniṣad is that the principle called Turīya, which is beyond all these embodied forms, is the Supreme Brahman. It was stated above that this is the fourth quarter of the Supreme Principle called Gāyatra. Describing these four quarters in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka, it praises thus: तस्या उपस्थानं गायत्रैकपदी, द्विपदी, त्रिपदी, चतुष्पद्यपदसि न हि पद्यसे । नमस्ते तुरीयाय दर्शताय पदाय परोरजसे (*tasyā upasthānaṃ gāyatraikapadī, dvipadī, tripadī, catuṣpadyapadasi na hi* *padyase | namaste turīyāya darśatāya padāya parorajase*) (Bṛ. U. 5-14-7). These four quarters, and the special meanings of epithets such as परोरजसे (*parorajase*), were explained above.

22. The embodied forms of Brahman, whose form is the supreme light (the divisions of the Vyāhṛtis beginning with Bhūḥ)

Just as it has been described how the Supreme Brahman, whose form is the supreme light, has evolved into the forms of light such as Agni, so it is stated in many places that the Praṇava, which consists of the Vyāhṛtis, has also evolved into the three worlds beginning with Bhūḥ, which are the support of the lights Agni, Vāyu and Āditya. And it is also settled that this Praṇava is none other than the Supreme Brahman. The Supreme Brahman, whose nature is Praṇava,

evolving in three ways and being called by other names suited to each place and time and to its nature, and being praised as of the nature of the Supreme Brahman by the Gāyatrī called Sāvitrī, is clearly stated in the Maitrī Upaniṣad. From this it is also clearly understood that the Gāyatrī consisting of the Vyāhṛtis and the Praṇava consisting of the Vyāhṛtis are other names of one Brahman-principle whose form is light. उपासीत ओमित्येतदक्षरेण व्याहृतिभिः सावित्रा चेति (*upāsīta omityetadakṣareṇa vyāhṛtibhiḥ sāvitrā ceti*) (3-62-10): one should meditate with the Vyāhṛtis, with the Praṇava and with the recitation of the Sāvitrī, and so attain realisation of Brahman. That Brahman-principle which is thus praised is described as having evolved in the form of the Vyāhṛtis and in the form of the Praṇava,[?297], and is praised by the Gāyatrī.

द्वे नाव ब्रह्मणो रूपे मूर्तं चामूर्तं चाथ तदसत्यं यदमूर्तं तत्सत्यं तद्ब्रह्म तज्योतिः यज्योतिः स आदित्यः स वा एष ओमित्येतदात्माभवत् स त्रेधात्मानं व्यकुरुता ओमिति तिस्रो मात्रा एताभिः सर्वमिदमोतं प्रोतं चैवास्मीत्येवं ह्याहैतद्वा आदित्य ओमित्येवं ध्यायत आत्मानं युंजीतेति ॥ (*dve nāva brahmaṇo rūpe mūrtaṃ cāmūrtaṃ cātha tadasatyaṃ yadamūrtaṃ tatsatyaṃ tadbrahma tajyotiḥ yajyotiḥ sa ādityaḥ sa vā eṣa omityetadātmābhavat sa tredhātmānaṃ vyakurutā omiti tisro mātrā etābhiḥ sarvamidamotaṃ protaṃ caivāsmītyevaṃ hyāhaitadvā āditya omityevaṃ dhyāyata ātmānaṃ yuṃjīteti ‖*) (Mai. U. 6-3)[?298]

Brahman has two forms: embodied and unembodied. The embodied is unreal; the unembodied is real. That is Brahman, real and of the form of light. This light is Āditya. For this Brahman, who is of the form of light and of the nature of Āditya, the Praṇava, the syllable Oṃ, is the Self. (As it is said in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka that Brahman evolved into three forms, Agni, Āditya and Vāyu, here too the same kind of division is stated.) This Praṇava has three forms: the letter a, the letter u and the letter m. By these parts of the Praṇava, a, u and m, the whole world is woven together like warp and woof (ota and prota). For that very reason Āditya, who is the Self of the universe, should be worshipped as of the nature of the Praṇava.

In the embodied form the nature of this Praṇava is threefold. These portions may also be called the limbs of the Supreme Self. Their forms are as follows:

अथान्यत्राप्युक्तं स्वनवत्येषास्य तनूर्या ओमिति (*athānyatrāpyuktaṃ svanavatyeṣāsya tanūryā omiti*) (Ā. U. Ma.)[?299]

अथ स्त्री, पुं, नपुंसक इति .... लिंगवत्येषा (*atha strī, puṃ, napuṃsaka iti .... liṃgavatyeṣā*)

अथ अग्निः, वायुः, आदित्य इति .... भास्वत्येषा (*atha agniḥ, vāyuḥ, āditya iti .... bhāsvatyeṣā*)

अथ ब्रह्म, रुद्रो. विष्णुरिति .... अधिपतिवत्येषा (*atha brahma, rudro. viṣṇuriti .... adhipativatyeṣā*)

अथ गार्हपत्यो दक्षिणाग्निराहवनीय इति .... मुखवत्येषा (*atha gārhapatyo dakṣiṇāgnirāhavanīya iti .... mukhavatyeṣā*)

अथ ऋग्यजुः सामेति .... विज्ञानवत्येषा (*atha ṛgyajuḥ sāmeti .... vijñānavatyeṣā*)

अथ भूः, भुवः, स्वः इति (*atha bhūḥ, bhuvaḥ, svaḥ iti*) .... लोकवत्येषा (*lokavatyeṣā*)

अथ भूतं भव्यं भविष्यदिति (*atha bhūtaṃ bhavyaṃ bhaviṣyaditi*) .... कालवत्येषा (*kālavatyeṣā*)

अथ प्राणोऽग्निस्ूर्य इति (*atha prāṇo 'gnisūrya iti*) .... प्रतापवत्येषा (*pratāpavatyeṣā*)

अथ अन्नमापश्चंद्रमा इति (*atha annamāpaścaṃdramā iti*) …. …. आप्यायनवत्येषा (*āpyāyanavatyeṣā*)

अथ बुद्धिर्मनोऽहंकार इति (*atha buddhirmano 'haṃkāra iti*) …. …. चेतनवत्येषा (*cetanavatyeṣā*)

अथ प्राणोऽपानो व्यान इति (*atha prāṇo 'pāno vyāna iti*) …. …. प्राणवत्येषा (*prāṇavatyeṣā*)

इत्यत ओमित्युक्तेनैताः प्रस्तुता अर्चिता अर्पिता भंवतीत्येवं …. …. …. ब्रह्मयदोमित्येतदक्षरमिति । (*ityata omityuktenaitāḥ prastutā arcitā arpitā bhaṃvatītyevaṃ …. …. …. brahmayadomityetadakṣaramiti* |) (Maitrī Upaniṣad 6-2)[?300]

Female, male and neuter: this is the division by gender. Agni, Vāyu and Āditya: this is of the nature of light. Brahmā, Rudra and Viṣṇu: this is in the form of lordship. Gārhapatya, Dakṣiṇāgni and Āhavanīya: this is of the nature of the mouth. Ṛk, Yajus and Sāman: this is of the nature of knowledge. It is of the nature of the worlds as Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ and Svaḥ; of the nature of time as past, present and future; of the form of heat as Prāṇa, Agni and Sūrya; of the form of growth as Anna, Āpaḥ and Candramas; of the form of consciousness as Buddhi, Manas and Ahaṃkāra; and of the form of life-breath as Prāṇa, Apāna and Vyāna. For this very reason Brahman is to be worshipped in the form of the Praṇava. The whole world also has the nature of the Vyāhṛtis, which are the parts of the Praṇava. For this very reason this Brahman is to be worshipped by the mantra तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*), which is a prayer addressed to the deity Savitṛ.

23. The Vyāhṛtis, which are the forms of the world beginning with the earth, are the chief means of worshipping Brahman, the root of it

In the above explanation, and also in the section that follows, two points should be noted. First, that the three worlds beginning with the earth were produced by the utterance of the Vyāhṛtis beginning with Bhūḥ. Second, that for this very reason Brahman is to be worshipped by means of the Vyāhṛtis, which are of the nature of the Gāyatrī.

अथाव्याहृतं वा इदमासीत् स सत्यं प्रजापतिस्तपस्तप्त्वा नुव्याहरदर्भुवस्स्वरित्येष्टैवास्य प्रजापतेः स्थविष्ठा तनूर्या लोकवतीति स्वरित्यस्याः शिरो नाभिर्भुवो भूः पादा आदित्यश्चक्षुः । चक्षुरायत्ता हि पुरुषस्य महती मात्रा चक्षुषा ह्ययं मात्राश्चरति सत्यं वै चक्षुरक्षिण्यवस्थितो हि पुरुष (*athāvyāhṛtaṃ vā idamāsīt sa satyaṃ prajāpatistapastaptvā nuvyāharadarbhuvassvarityeṣṭaivāsya prajāpateḥ sthaviṣṭhā tanūryā lokavatīti svarityasyāḥ śiro nābhirbhuvo bhūḥ pādā ādityaścakṣuḥ | cakṣurāyattā hi puruṣasya mahatī mātrā cakṣuṣā hyayaṃ mātrāścarati satyaṃ vai cakṣurakṣiṇyavasthito hi puruṣa*)

सर्वार्थेषु चरत्येतस्मात् भूर्भुवः स्वरित्युपासीतानेन हि प्रजापतिर्विश्वात्मा विश्वचक्षुरिवोपासितो भवतीत्येवं ह्याहैषा वै .... तस्मादेषोपासीत ॥ (*sarvārtheṣu caratyetasmāt bhūrbhuvaḥ svarityupāsītānena hi prajāpatirviśvātmā viśvacakṣurivopāsito bhavatītyevaṃ hyāhaiṣā vai .... tasmādeṣopāsīta ||*) (Mai. U. 6-6)

In the beginning this universe was unmanifest. The Supreme Person, real in nature and in the form of Prajāpati, performed austerity and uttered: Bhūḥ (the earth), Bhuvaḥ (the atmosphere), Svaḥ (the world of Āditya). This is the gross form of Prajāpati, consisting of the universe. The world of Āditya is the head of this form; the atmosphere is the navel; the earth is the feet. The eye, the means of seeing everything, is of the form of Āditya. For this very reason Brahman is to be worshipped by the means consisting of the Vyāhṛtis Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ, Svaḥ. Brahman, in the form of Prajāpati, is the inner self of all worlds, the divine eye, and the one worshipped by the whole world. The Brahman in whom the whole universe is contained, in the form of Prajāpati, is to be worshipped by the Gāyatrī mantra, which is called Sāvitrī and is of the form of the Vyāhṛtis. Its method is as follows:

तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यमित्यसौ ना आदित्यः सविता स वा एवं प्रवरणीय आत्मकामेनेत्याहुर्ब्रह्मवादिनः ॥ (*tatsaviturvareṇyamityasau nā ādityaḥ savitā sa vā evaṃ pravaraṇīya ātmakāmenetyāhurbrahmavādinaḥ ||*)

"That most worshipful great radiance of Savitṛ": who is that Savitṛ? Āditya, who shines in the heavenly world, is Savitṛ. The Brahmavādins have taught that a person who desires to contemplate the Self should worship this Savitṛ, knowing his nature.

भर्गो देवस्य धीमहीति सविता वै देवस्ततो योऽस्य भर्गाख्यस्तं चिंतयामीत्याहुर्ब्रह्मवादिनः ॥ (*bhargo devasya dhīmahīti savitā vai devastato yo 'sya bhargākhyastaṃ ciṃtayāmītyāhurbrahmavādinaḥ ‖*)

"May we know and meditate on the Bharga of that Savitṛ." This Savitṛ is the Supreme Brahman. The teaching of the Brahmavādins is that one should contemplate him.

धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् इति बुद्धयो वै धियः यो नः प्रचोदयादिति बुद्धयो वै धियस्ता योऽस्माकं प्रचोदयादित्याहुर्ब्रह्मावादिनः ॥ (*dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt iti buddhayo vai dhiyaḥ yo naḥ pracodayāditi buddhayo vai dhiyastā yo 'smākaṃ pracodayādityāhurbrahmāvādinaḥ ‖*) (Mai. U. 6-7)

"May that same Savitṛ produce insight in us; may he give us the vitality to know the Bharga of Savitṛ": this is what one should pray, the Brahmavādins have said. Thus the Maitrī Upaniṣad gives an explanation in the form of a derivation of the Ṛk beginning तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*). It will be stated later among the special topics of this same mantra.

24. Direct realisation of this light, famed as the Bharga of Savitṛ, is possible only through meditation.

अथ यदतः पुरो दिवो ज्योतिर्दिप्यते विश्वतः पृष्ठेषु सर्वतः पृष्ठेष्वनुत्तमेषूत्तमेषु लोकेष्टिदं वाव तद्यदिदमस्मिन्नंतः पुरुषे ज्योतिः ॥ ((*atha yadataḥ puro divo jyotirdipyate viśvataḥ pṛṣṭheṣu sarvataḥ pṛṣṭheṣvanuttameṣūttameṣu lokeṣṭidaṃ vāva tadyadidamasminnaṃtaḥ puruṣe jyotiḥ ‖ ()* (Chā. U. 3-13-7)

The great light that shines in the highest world, beyond the heavenly world and beyond which there is no other world, is the very light that shines also in the lotus of the heart of man. The great radiance so described in the Chāndogya and other texts is praised here under the name of the Bharga of Savitṛ. This light is the supreme light of the Supreme Principle. For this reason it is indicated in the Brahmasūtra by the sūtra ज्योतिश्चरणाभिधानात् (*jyotiścaraṇābhidhānāt*) (Bra. Sū. 1-1-25). The objection that may be raised on this occasion, put by the opponent, and the answer given to it, were also stated above. The sūtra छंदोभिधानान्नेति चेन्न (*chaṃdobhidhānānneti cenna*)

(1-1-26) was likewise explained above, showing that the Gāyatrī as metre is not merely of eight syllables, but that the Supreme Brahman itself is indicated by this metre.

गायत्राख्यच्छंदोद्वारेण तदनुगते ब्रह्मणि चेतसोऽर्पणं चित्तसमाधानमनेन ब्राह्मणवाक्येन निगद्यते । (*gāyatrākhyacchaṃdodvāreṇa tadanugate brahmaṇi cetaso 'rpaṇaṃ cittasamādhānamanena brāhmaṇavākyena nigadyate* |) (Bra. Sū. 80. 1-1-25)[?301]

It is understood that through the metre called Gāyatra one should wholly offer the mind to Brahman, who pervades it, and practise meditation of that nature. In the present prayer भर्गो देवस्य धीमहि (*bhargo devasya dhīmahi*) the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) conveys both knowledge and meditation. Sāyaṇa has given the purport of the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) as परब्रह्मात्मकं तेजः धैयतया मनसा धारयामः (*parabrahmātmakaṃ tejaḥ dhaiyatayā manasā dhārayāmaḥ*). In places such as शाधि यां देवतामुपास्ये (*śādhi yāṃ devatāmupāsye*)[?302] and तं पश्यते निष्कलं ध्यायमानः (*taṃ paśyate niṣkalaṃ dhyāyamānaḥ*) (Mu. U. 3-1-8)[?303], the three roots उपास् (*upās*), विद् (*vid*) and धै (*dhai*) are all used in the sense of knowledge consisting of meditation. In the same way, when it says भर्गो देवस्य धीमहि (*bhargo devasya dhīmahi*), the purport is likewise meditation consisting of knowledge. But one must also understand how this meditation consisting of knowledge is possible through the Gāyatrī, and what its manner is.

युंजते मन उत युंजते धियो विप्रा विप्रस्य बृहतो विपश्चितः । वि होत्रा दधे वयुनाविदेक इन्मही देवस्य सवितुः परिष्टुतिः ॥ (*yuṃjate mana uta yuṃjate dhiyo viprā viprasya bṛhato vipaścitaḥ | vi hotrā dadhe vayunāvideka inmahī devasya savituḥ pariṣṭutiḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-1)[?304]

In this meditation, which describes how the wise ṛṣis concentrate their minds and perform meditation on Savitṛ, everything that man is to meditate on is indicated. But what should the manner of this meditation be? What is its object? How is the Gāyatrī the chief means for this meditation directed to Brahman? Or how does realisation of Brahman, called Gāyatra, come from meditation in the form of the Gāyatrī?

25. The nature of the Praṇava, which is the means of meditation and consists of the Vyāhṛtis.

तज्योतिर्यज्योतिः स आदित्यः स वा एष ओमित्येतदात्माभवत् स त्रेधात्मानं व्यकुरुता ओमिति तिस्रो मात्रा एताभिः सर्वमिदमोतं प्रोतं चैवास्मीत्येवं ह्याहृतद्वा आदित्य ओमित्येवं ध्यायत आत्मानं युंजीतेति॥ (*tajyotiryajyotiḥ sa ādityaḥ sa vā eṣa omityetadātmābhavat sa tredhātmānaṃ vyakurutā omiti tisro mātrā etābhiḥ sarvamidamotaṃ protaṃ caivāsmītyevaṃ hyāhṛtadvā āditya omityevaṃ dhyāyata ātmānaṃ yuṃjīteti*‖) (Mai. U. 6-3)

The light of Āditya described above evolved in the form of Oṃ. It became threefold. It was also stated above that the whole world is woven together, as warp and woof, by this Oṃkāra, which consists of the three Vyāhṛtis. Therefore realisation of this light of Āditya is possible only through the Praṇava, which consists of the Vyāhṛtis and of Oṃkāra and indicates the whole world beginning with Bhūḥ. By meditation of the nature of the Praṇava, the unity of all the worlds, though they are diverse, is also directly realised.

एतत्तेजो यदसावादित्य ओमित्येतदक्षरस्य चैतत् तस्मादोमित्यनेनैतदुपासीताजस्रं इत्येकोऽस्य संबोधयिता ॥ (*etattejo yadasāvāditya omityetadakṣarasya caitat tasmādomityanenaitadupāsītājasraṃ ityeko 'sya saṃbodhayitā* ‖) (Mai. U. 6-4)

Āditya, who is the one awakener (illuminator) of the whole universe and of the nature of the Praṇava, is to be known only through meditation in the form of Oṃkāra. But the relation between the Gāyatrī and the Praṇava, when they serve as the means of meditation, has been stated above. The nature of both is of the form of the Vyāhṛtis beginning with Bhū. Moreover the Praṇava is itself a part of the Gāyatrī.

नवाक्षराणि गायत्र्यष्टौ तानि यान्यन्वाह प्रणवो नवमः ॥ (*navākṣarāṇi gāyatryaṣṭau tāni yānyanvāha praṇavo navamaḥ* ‖) (Śa. Brā. 3-4-1-15)

The Gāyatrī consists of nine syllables. The Praṇava, which is the syllable Oṃ, is the ninth. The Praṇava is a part of the mantra that is to be recited as eight-syllabled. The passage thus shows that the Praṇava, which must always be recited together with the Gāyatrī (itself a means of meditation), is also of the nature of the Gāyatrī. In the same way as the Gāyatrī is praised, in the words गायत्रि वा इदग्ं सर्व०

भूतं (*gāyatri vā idagṃ sarvao bhūtaṃ*) and so on, as the all-pervading form of the Supreme Brahman, it is shown that no mantra is higher than the Praṇava, since it expounds the Brahman-principle that lies beyond the three times: न हि प्रणवादधिकं किंचिन्मंत्रजात्रमस्ति त्रिकालातीतस्य ब्रह्मणः प्रतिपादकत्वात्. (*na hi praṇavādadhikaṃ kiṃcinmaṃtrajātramasti trikālātītasya brahmaṇaḥ pratipādakatvāt.*). The greatness of this Praṇava is described thus:

ओमित्येतदक्षरमिदग्ं सर्वं तस्योपव्याख्यानं भूतं भवद्भविष्यदिति सर्वमोंकार एव । यच्चान्यत्रिकालातीतं तदप्योंकार एव ॥ (*omityetadakṣaramidagṃ sarvaṃ tasyopavyākhyānaṃ bhūtaṃ bhavadbhaviṣyaditi sarvamoṃkāra eva | yaccānyatrikālātītaṃ tadapyoṃkāra eva* ‖) (Mā. U. 1)[?305]

The whole universe consists of Oṃkāra. Therefore the Praṇava in the form of Oṃkāra is the Supreme Brahman. Commenting on this sentence, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya says:

यदिदं अर्थजातं अभिधेयभूतं तस्य अभिधानाव्यतिरेकात् अभिधानस्य च ओंकाराव्यतिरेकात् ओंकार एवेदं सर्वं परं च ब्रह्म अभिधानाभिधेयोपायपूर्वकमेव गम्यत इति ओंकार एव । तस्य एतस्य परापरब्रह्मरूपस्य अक्षरस्य ओं इत्येतस्य उपव्याख्यानं ॥ (*yadidaṃ arthajātaṃ abhidheyabhūtaṃ tasya abhidhānāvyatirekāt abhidhānasya ca oṃkārāvyatirekāt oṃkāra evedaṃ sarvaṃ paraṃ ca brahma abhidhānābhidheyopāyapūrvakameva gamyata iti oṃkāra eva | tasya etasya parāparabrahmarūpasya akṣarasya oṃ ityetasya upavyākhyānaṃ* ‖) (Mā. U. Śaṅkara-bhāṣya 1)[?306]

All the things in the world that are denoted by name and form, and are thus objects of denotation, consist of Oṃkāra. The denotation itself (the manner of denoting) is also Oṃkāra. Since the Supreme Brahman too is known only by way of the means called denotation and the denoted, it too is Oṃkāra. The explanation of this syllable Oṃ, which is of the form of the higher and the lower Brahman, is a means to the understanding of Brahman and therefore stands close to Brahman; thus he has shown the identity of the Praṇava with Brahman. Here only the significance of the Praṇava at the time of reciting the Gāyatrī, which is a means to the realisation of Brahman, is examined. Just as the Upaniṣad texts describe the Gāyatrī, which is of the form of Brahman, as the direct means to the knowledge of

Brahman, so too the Praṇava, which is a part of the Gāyatrī and of the form of Brahman, is a chief limb of the meditation in the form of the Gāyatrī, and is a direct means to the realisation of Brahman, which is one with it; this is also stated clearly.

एतद्वाव तत्स्वरूपं नभसः खेंतर्भूतस्य यत् परं तेजस्तत्रेधाभिहितमग्नावादित्ये प्राण एतद्वाव तत् स्वरूपं नभसः खेंतर्भूतस्य यदो- मित्येतदक्षरमनेनैव तदुद्भुद्यत्युदयत्युच्छूसत्यजस्रं ब्रह्मधीयालंबं .... ॥ (*etadvāva tatsvarūpaṃ nabhasaḥ kheṃtarbhūtasya yat paraṃ tejastatredhābhihitamagnāvāditye prāṇa etadvāva tat svarūpaṃ nabhasaḥ kheṃtarbhūtasya yado-mityetadakṣaramanenaiva tadudbhudyatyudayatyucchūsatyajasraṃ brahmadhīyālaṃbaṃ ....* ‖) (Maitrī Upaniṣad 7-11)[?307]

The space in the lotus of the heart is the supreme light. It has become transformed into the forms of Āditya, Vāyu and Agni (this has been explained earlier). The Brahman-principle that is of the nature of space in the lotus of the heart is itself the Praṇava in the form of Oṃkāra. From this Praṇava alone the supreme light arises, rises, and spreads to the whole universe. This light is the support of the universe. The Gāyatrī form, which is the mother of the metres and the essence of the Vedas, is of the nature of this Praṇava. (एतद्वाव तत्स्वरूपं (*etadvāva tatsvarūpaṃ*)) In the time of meditation, contemplating this is contemplating Brahman. Through this complete contemplation one can know that the goal and the means are one. That this Praṇava is Brahman is shown thus:

ओमिति ब्रह्म । ओमितीदगं् सर्वं । ओमित्येतदनुकृति ह स्म वा अप्यो श्रावयेत्याश्रावयंति । ओमिति सामानि गायंति । ओगं् शोमिति शस्त्राणि शगं्संति । ओमित्यध्वर्युः प्रतिगरं प्रतिगृणाति । ओमिति ब्रह्मा प्रसौति । ओमित्यग्निहोत्रमनुजानाति । ओमिति ब्राह्मणः प्रवक्ष्यन्नाह ब्रह्मोपाप्नवानीति । ब्रह्मैवोपाप्णोति ॥ (*omiti brahma | omitīdagṃ sarvaṃ | omityetadanukṛti ha sma vā apyo śrāvayetyāśrāvayaṃti | omiti sāmāni gāyaṃti | ogṃ śomiti śastrāṇi śagṃsaṃti | omityadhvaryuḥ pratigaraṃ pratigṛṇāti | omiti brahmā prasauti | omityagnihotramanujānāti | omiti brāhmaṇaḥ pravakṣyannāha brahmopāpnavānīti | brahmaivopāpṇoti* ‖) (Trai. U. 1-8)[?308]

Oṃ (the Praṇava) is Brahman. The whole universe is Oṃ. That is the imitation. Those who sing the Sāman, and the Adhvaryu and others, utter the response (pratigara) with it. One who studies the Veda, before beginning study, with the thought "Let me obtain Brahman", obtains Brahman itself by uttering Oṃkāra. Oṃ means the Supreme Self; by uttering it the Supreme Self is attained.

स य एतदेवं विद्वानक्षरं प्रणत्येतदेवाक्षरं स्वरममृतमभयं प्रविशति तत्प्रविश्य यदमृता देवास्त्रदमृतो भवति ॥ (*sa ya etadevaṃ vidvānakṣaraṃ praṇatyetadevākṣaraṃ svaramamṛtamabhayaṃ praviśati tatpraviśya yadamṛtā devāstradamṛto bhavati ‖*) (Chā. U. 1-4-5)

This Praṇava in the form of Oṃkāra is immortal and of the nature of fearlessness. The gods too took refuge in it and obtained immortality and fearlessness. Those who know this truth and take refuge in this sound in the form of Oṃkāra become immortal and obtain fearlessness. How is it possible that the state of mind indicated by the mantra beginning युंजते मन उत युंजते (*yuṃjate mana uta yuṃjate*), and the meditative search for knowledge in it, accomplish the goal through the power of the Praṇava?—

प्रणवो धनुः शरो ह्यात्मा ब्रह्म तल्लक्ष्यमुच्यते । अप्रमत्तेन वेद्धव्यं शरवत्तन्मयो भवेत् ॥ (*praṇavo dhanuḥ śaro hyātmā brahma tallakṣyamucyate | apramattena veddhavyaṃ śaravattanmayo bhavet ‖*) (Mu. U. 2-2-4)?309

The Praṇava is the bow. The Self is the arrow. Brahman is the target. It must be pierced without heedlessness. One must become one with it, like the arrow. Just as the bow is the cause of the arrow's going and reaching the target, so the Praṇava must be the means by which the arrow called the Self reaches the target called the Imperishable. Thus the nature of the Praṇava as a means of meditation is shown. And further:

यः पुनरेतं त्रिमात्रेणोमित्येतेनैवाक्षरेण परं पुरुषमभिध्यायीत स तेजसि सूर्ये संपन्नः । यथा पादोदरस्त्वचा विनिर्मुच्यत एवं ह वै स पाप्मना विनिर्मुक्तः स सामभिरुन्नीयते ब्रह्मलोकं स एतस्माज्जीवघनात्परात्परं पुरिशयं पुरुषमीक्षते ॥ (*yaḥ punaretaṃ trimātreṇomityetenaivākṣareṇa paraṃ puruṣamabhidhyāyīta sa tejasi sūrye saṃpannaḥ | yathā pādodarastvacā vinirmucyata evaṃ ha vai* *sa pāpmanā vinirmuktaḥ sa sāmabhirunnīyate brahmalokaṃ sa etasmājjīvaghanātparātparaṃ puriśayaṃ puruṣamīkṣate* ‖) (Praśna. U. 5-5)[?310]

The man who meditates on the Supreme Person with the help of the three mātrās a, u, m — which are the parts of the Praṇava and which also denote the three worlds Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ, Svaḥ, the parts of the Gāyatrī — attains union with the radiance of Āditya. As a serpent casts off its slough and becomes clean, such a worshipper too wholly casts off his sin and becomes pure. He is carried to the world of Brahman by means of the Sāman chant. He obtains the vision of the Supreme Self, who is higher than the whole mass of conscious living beings and dwells within the heart. And the fruit of this meditation is:

तिस्रो मात्रा मृत्युमत्यः प्रयुक्ता अन्नोन्यसक्ता अनविप्रयुक्ताः । क्रियासु बाह्याभ्यंतरमध्यमासु सम्यक्प्रयुक्तासु न कंपते ज्ञः ॥ (*tisro mātrā mṛtyumatyaḥ prayuktā annonyasaktā anaviprayuktāḥ | kriyāsu bāhyābhyaṃtaramadhyamāsu samyakprayuktāsu na kaṃpate jñaḥ* ‖) (Pra. U. 5-6)[?311]

If these three mātrās are separated and used without relation of one to another, they become destructive. If, in all the bodily actions of man — external, internal and intermediate — one worships by joining them all together so as to bring them into harmony, and obtains their power for all one's dealings, then the man, fearing nothing in any circumstance, remains unshaken.

ऋग्भिरेतं यजुर्भिरंतरिक्षं सामभिर्यत्तत्कवयो वेदयंते । तमोंकारेणैवायतनेनान्वेति विद्वान्यत्तच्छांतमजरममृतभयं परं चेति॥ (*ṛgbhiretaṃ yajurbhiraṃtarikṣaṃ sāmabhiryattatkavayo vedayaṃte | tamoṃkāreṇaivāyatanenānveti vidvānyattacchāṃtamajaramamṛtabhayaṃ paraṃ ceti*‖) (Pra. U. 5-7)

The man who worships in this manner obtains this world by the Ṛks, the atmosphere by the Yajus, and by the Sāmans the world of Āditya which the seers perceive. And further, with the help of Oṃkāra, which is the synthesis of all these, he realises the principle that is tranquil, free from old age, free from death, free from fear and higher than the highest.

By these descriptions and explanations above, the common nature of the Gāyatrī and the Praṇava has been indicated. Although the order of utterance in time states that, from the practical standpoint, the Praṇava comes first and the Gāyatrī afterwards, the nature and power of the Praṇava are indeed the nature and power of the Gāyatrī.

26. The Praṇava and the Gāyatrī are both forms of Brahman; the fruit of worshipping Brahman in the form of the Vyāhṛtis Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ, Suvaḥ, Mahaḥ.

If these two, which are direct means to the realisation of Brahman, are said to be forms of Brahman, then it becomes necessary at once to examine such matters as: what are the Vyāhṛtis, which are worldly divisions of the Brahman indicated as Savitṛ and which are parts common to the Praṇava and the Gāyatrī; how many are their divisions; and what is the nature of the Vyāhṛtis as aids to meditation that is of the nature of the Praṇava and of the Gāyatrī. It was stated above that the Maitrī Upaniṣad explains the letters a, u, m of the Praṇava as masculine, feminine and neuter, and in other ways. Similar divisions are given, somewhat differently, in the Taittirīya Upaniṣad also. The divisions in the Taittirīya Upaniṣad have gained great importance from the standpoint of spiritual knowledge and of worship. Śaṅkarācārya too has given these divisions great prominence from the standpoint of worship and explained them at length. The divisions are given thus in the Taittirīya:

अनंतरं व्याहृत्यात्मनो ब्रह्मणः अंतरुपासनं स्वाराज्यफलं प्रस्तुयते (*anaṃtaraṃ vyāhṛtyātmano brahmaṇaḥ aṃtarupāsanaṃ svārājyaphalaṃ prastuyate*) (Tai. U. Śa. Bhā. 1-5)?[312]

Having stated that worship concerning the Saṃhitās also is a means to knowledge, Śaṅkarācārya says in his introduction to the worship of Brahman through the Vyāhṛtis that the method is now stated of worshipping inwardly the Brahman in the form of the Vyāhṛtis, which gives the fruit called svārājya. Its order is as follows—

भूर्भुवः सुवरिति वा एतास्तिस्रो व्याहृतयः । तासा मुहस्मै तां चतुर्थीं। माहाचमस्यः प्रवेदयते । मह इति । तत् ब्रह्म । स आत्मा । अंगान्यन्या देवताः । भूरिति वा अयं लोकः । भुव इत्यंतरिक्षं । सुवरित्यसौ लोकः । मह इत्यादित्यः । आदित्येन वाव सर्वे लोका महीयंते । भूरिति ना अग्निः । भुव इति वायुः । सुवरित्यादित्यः । मह इति चंद्रमाः । चंद्रमसा वाव सर्वाणि ज्योतिर्गंषि महीयंते । भूरिति वा ऋचः । भुव इति सामानि । सुवरिति यजूंगंषि । मह इति ब्रह्म । ब्रह्मणा वाव सर्वे वेदा महीयंते । भूरिति वै प्राणः । भुव इत्यपानः । सुवरिति व्यानः । मह इत्यन्नं । अन्नेन वाव सर्वे प्राणा महीयंते । ता वा एताश्चतस्रश्चतुर्धा। चितस्रश्चतस्रो व्याहृतयः । ता यो वेद । स वेद ब्रह्म । सर्वेऽस्मै देवा बलिमावहंति ॥ (*bhūrbhuvaḥ suvariti vā etāstisro vyāhṛtayaḥ | tāsā muhasmai tāṃ caturthīṃ| māhācamasyaḥ pravedayate | maha iti | tat brahma | sa ātmā | aṃgānyanyā devatāḥ | bhūriti vā ayaṃ lokaḥ | bhuva ityaṃtarikṣaṃ | suvarityasau lokaḥ | maha ityādityaḥ | ādityena vāva sarvè lokā mahīyaṃte | bhūriti nā agniḥ | bhuva iti vāyuḥ | suvarityādityaḥ | maha iti caṃdramāḥ | caṃdramasā vāva sarvāṇi jyotirgaṃṣi mahīyaṃte | bhūriti vā ṛcaḥ | bhuva iti sāmāni | suvariti yajūgaṃṣi | maha iti brahma | brahmaṇā vāva sarve vedā mahīyaṃte | bhūriti vai prāṇaḥ | bhuva ityapānaḥ | suvariti vyānaḥ | maha ityannaṃ | annena vāva sarvè prāṇā mahīyaṃte | tā vā etāścatasraścaturdhā| citasraścatasro vyāhṛtayaḥ | tā yo veda | sa veda brahma | sarve 'smai devā balimāvahaṃti* ‖) (Kṛ. U. 1-5)[?313]

The three Vyāhṛtis Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ, Suvaḥ, which are limbs, are the three; the fourth Vyāhṛti, Mahaḥ, was made known by Māhācamasya. (ऋष्यनुस्मरणमपि उपासनांगं (*ṛṣyanusmaraṇamapi upāsanāṃgaṃ*) — remembering the seer's name is also a limb of worship.) This Vyāhṛti, bearing the name Mahaḥ, is the great Brahman. It is the all-pervading Self. All the rest are its limbs.

इतराश्च वाहृतयो लोकाः देवाः वेदाः प्राणाश्च महः इत्यनेन व्याहृत्यात्मना आदित्यचंद्रब्रह्मान्नभूतेन वाप्यंते यतः ॥ (*itarāśca vāhṛtayo lokāḥ devāḥ vedāḥ prāṇāśca mahaḥ ityanena vyāhṛtyātmanā ādityacaṃdrabrahmānnabhūtena vāpyaṃte yataḥ* ‖) (Śa. Bhā.)[?314]

All the worlds beginning with Bhūḥ, the gods, the Vedas and the vital airs are pervaded by the Self in the form of the great Vyāhṛti, which has the forms of the sun, the moon, Brahman and food, called Mahaḥ. Therefore all of them are limbs of this Self called Mahaḥ. In the statement अंगान्यन्या देवताः (*aṃgānyanyā devatāḥ*), the word "deities" is used as an indicator; all worldly beings pervaded by the Self are included in it. The order of the division ता वा एताश्च तस्रश्चतुर्धा (*tā vā etāśca tasraścaturdhā*) is as follows—

1. Bhūḥ is this world. Bhuvaḥ is the atmosphere. Suvaḥ is the world of heaven. Mahaḥ is Āditya. By Āditya all the worlds become great. This is the Supreme Brahman, the inner controller of all.
2. Bhūḥ is Agni, Bhuvaḥ is Vāyu, Suvaḥ is Āditya. Mahaḥ is the moon. By the moon all the lights become great. (It was stated earlier, in Sūkta 1-164, that this moon-world is beyond the world of Āditya and does not mean the familiar disc of the moon.
3. Bhūḥ is the Ṛks. Bhuvaḥ is the Sāmans. Suvaḥ is the Yajus texts. Mahaḥ is Brahman; by Brahman all become great.
4. In the fourth division, Bhūḥ is prāṇa, Bhuvaḥ is apāna, Suvaḥ is vyāna, and Mahaḥ is food. Food is the cause of the greatness of all the vital airs.

Thus each of them is of four kinds. He who knows their nature fully is as one who has known the complete Brahman. All the gods serve him and offer him tribute.

The method of worship, which is the means to the realisation of the Supreme Brahman — of that form of Brahman explained above, in which all the other deities named Bhūḥ, Bhuvaḥ, Suvaḥ are limbs of the Brahman known as Mahaḥ — is also stated in the Taittirīya thus:

स य एषोंतर्हृदय आकाशः । तस्मिन्नयं पुरुषो मनोमयः । अमृतो हिरण्मयः । अंतरेण तालुके। य एषस्तन इवावलंबते । सेंद्रयोनिः । यत्रासौ केशांतो विवर्तते । व्यपोह्य शीर्षकपाले । भूरित्यग्नौ प्रतितिष्ठति । भुव इति वायौ । सुवरित्यादित्ये । मह इति ब्रह्मणि । अप्पोति स्वाराज्यं । अप्पोति मनसस्पतिं । वाक्पतिश्चक्षुष्पतिः । श्रोत्रपतिर्विज्ञानपतिः । एतत्ततो भवति । आकाशशरीरं ब्रह्म । सत्यात्मप्राणारावं मन आनंदं शांतिसमृद्धममृतं । इति प्राचीनयोगोपास्त्व ॥ (*sa ya eṣoṃtarhṛdaya ākāśaḥ | tasminnayaṃ puruṣo manomayaḥ | amṛto hiraṇmayaḥ | aṃtareṇa tāluke | ya eṣastana ivāvalaṃbate | seṃdrayoniḥ | yatrāsau keśāṃto vivartate | vyapohya śīrṣakapāle | bhūrityagnau pratitiṣṭhati | bhuva iti vāyau | suvarityāditye | maha* *iti brahmaṇi | appoti svārājyaṃ | appoti manasaspatiṃ | vākpatiścakṣuṣpatiḥ | śrotrapatirvijñānapatiḥ | etattato bhavati | ākāśaśarīraṃ brahma | satyātmaprāṇārāvaṃ mana ānaṃdaṃ śāṃtisamṛddhamamṛtaṃ | iti prācīnayogopāstva ||*) (Kṛ. U. 1-6)[?315]

In the space within the heart there is a Person, consisting of mind, immortal, golden. What hangs between the two jaws like a breast, where the ends of the hair part in two, is the womb of Indra. The worshipper is established in Agni called Bhūḥ, in Vāyu called Bhuvaḥ, in Āditya called Suvaḥ, in Brahman called Mahaḥ. He obtains svārājya. He becomes lord of the mind. He becomes lord of the speech organs, of the eyes, of the ears, and of the faculties of knowledge. Beyond that, he is established in Brahman, whose body is space, who is the Self of all, who delights in the vital airs, whose mind is bliss, who is rich in peace and immortal, and he becomes of the form of Brahman itself.

तेषु आत्मभावेन स्थित्वा आप्नोति ब्रह्मभूतः स्वाराज्यं स्वराड्भावं । स्वयमेव राजा अधिपतिर्भवति अंगभूतानां देवानां यथाब्रह्म ॥ (*teṣu ātmabhāvena sthitvā āpnoti brahmabhūtaḥ svārājyaṃ svarāḍbhāvaṃ | svayameva rājā adhipatirbhavati aṃgabhūtānāṃ devānāṃ yathābrahma ||*) (Śa. Bhā.)

Abiding in all the vyāhṛtis with the feeling of identity with the Self, and becoming Brahman itself, he obtains svārājya, that is, the state of being self-ruling. He himself is the king. Just as Brahman is the overlord of the gods who are its limbs, so he too is the overlord. Just as all the gods offer tribute to Brahman, so they offer it to him. Just as Brahman, being the Self of all, is lord of all minds, so he too becomes. For that reason he becomes one who delights in the Self, one whose nature is bliss, one of tranquil mind, one free from death. From this it is understood that the instruction given to Prācīnayogya, "Worship Brahman who has the vyāhṛtis as its Self," teaches the nature of the worship that takes the form of the vyāhṛtis.

27. The Gāyatrī and the Praṇava, which praise the divine song of Brahman in the form of the Āditya, are themselves of the nature of song.

Thus the Śrutis praise the Praṇava and the Gāyatrī, which consist of the vyāhṛtis bhūḥ and the rest, as the direct means of meditating on the Supreme Reality that pervades all the worlds, bhūḥ and the rest, designated by their syllables. The great mantra Gāyatrī has been described as गायति (*gāyati*) and त्रायते च (*trāyate ca*) ("it protects and it sings"), and so its special quality is shown. In the same way the Praṇava, which is of the nature of the syllable Om, is also praised.

ओं इत्येतदक्षरमुद्गीथमुपासीत । ओमिति ह्युद्धायति ॥ (*oṃ ityetadakṣaramudgīthamupāsīta | omiti hyuddhāyati* ‖) (Bhā. U. 8-1-1)[?316]

The syllable Om is to be worshipped as the udgītha. It praises the reality of Brahman in the form of song. This Brahman-reality, which pervades the universe, abides in the form of the udgītha.

अथ खलु य उद्गीथः स प्रणवो यः प्रणव स उद्गीथ इत्यसौ वा आदित्य उद्गीथ एष प्रणव ओमिति ह्येष स्वरन्नेति ॥ (*atha khalu ya udgīthaḥ sa praṇavo yaḥ praṇava sa udgītha ityasau vā āditya udgītha eṣa praṇava omiti hyeṣa svaranneti* ‖) (Chā. U. 1.-5-8)

The udgītha is the praṇava; the praṇava is the udgītha. The Āditya is the udgītha and is of the nature of the praṇava. The Brahman who is in the form of the Āditya is the one that is called praṇava and udgītha; the Puruṣa who dwells within the heart of a person is also in this very form. How?

अथ य एषोऽंतरक्षिणि पुरुषो दृश्यते सैवर्काम .... यावमुप गोष्णौ गोष्णौ यन्नाम तन्नाम ॥ (*atha ya eṣo 'ṃtarakṣiṇi puruṣo dṛśyate saivarkāma .... yāvamupa goṣṇau goṣṇau yannāma tannāma* ‖) (Śrī. Ṭi. Si. 2-5)[?317]

Just as in the world of the Āditya the Supreme Reality moves about in the form of song, so the reality within the person also moves about in the form of song, by the same name and in the same manner. The meaning is that this divine Puruṣa, who is of the nature of song, is to be worshipped with the praṇava, which is of the nature of song and protects the world, and with the great Gāyatrī mantra. By the recitation of this Gāyatrī, which is the direct means to the realisation of Brahman and is itself of the form of Brahman, all the sins of a human being are destroyed.

अग्निरेव मुखं यदि ह वा अपि बह्विवाग्नावभ्यादधति सर्वमेव तत्संदहत्येवं हैवैवं विद्यद्यपि बह्विव पापं कुरुते सर्वमेव तत्संप्स्याय शुद्धः पूतोऽजरोऽमृतः संभवति ॥ (*agnireva mukhaṃ yadi ha vā api bahvivāgnāvabhyādadhati sarvameva tatsaṃdahatyevaṃ haivaivaṃ vidyadyapi bahviva pāpaṃ kurute sarvameva tatsaṃpsyāya śuddhaḥ pūto 'jaro 'mṛtaḥ saṃbhavati ‖*) (Bṛ. U. 5-14-8)

The mouth of the Gāyatrī is Agni. Just as whatever substance, however great in quantity, is placed in fire, the fire consumes it entirely, so for a man who knows the reality of the Gāyatrī, however many sins he may have committed, all his sins are destroyed and he becomes ageless, immortal, pure and of sanctified self. Thus the great power of the Gāyatrī is described. To make known that one who knows the power of this great mantra and worships it attains the nearness of Brahman and becomes Brahman itself, its greatness is described in the Taittirīya Āraṇyaka in the form of a story, as follows.

28. Praise of the Gāyatrī.

रक्षागं्सि ह वा पुरोऽनुवाकेतपोऽग्रमतिष्ठंत तान्प्रजापतिर्वरेणोपामंत्रयत तानि वरमवृणीतादित्यो नो योद्रा इति तान्प्रजापतिरब्रवीद्योधयध्वमिति तस्मादुत्तिष्ठंतगं् ह वा तानि रक्षाग्स्यादित्यं योधयंति यावदस्तमन्वगात्तानि ह वा एतानि रक्षागं्सि गायत्रियाभिमंत्रितेनांभसा शाम्यंति तदु ह वा एते ब्रह्मवादिनः पूर्वाभिमुखास्संध्यायां गायत्रियाभिमंत्रिता आप ऊर्ध्व० विक्षिपंति ता एता आपो वज्री भूत्वा तानि रक्षागं्सि मंदेहारुणे द्वीपे प्रक्षिपंति यत्पदक्षिणं प्रक्रमंति तेन पाप्नानमवधून्वंत्युद्यंतमस्तंयंतमादित्यमभिध्यायन्कुर्वन् ब्राह्मणो विद्वान्स कलं भद्रमश्नुतेऽसावादित्यो ब्रह्मेति ब्रह्मैव सन् ब्रह्माप्येति य एवं वेद ॥ (*rakṣāgṃsi ha vā puro 'nuvāke tapo 'gramatiṣṭhaṃta tānprajāpatirvareṇopāmaṃtrayata tāni varamavṛṇītādityo no yodrā iti tānprajāpatirabravīdyodhayadhvamiti tasmāduttiṣṭhaṃtagṃ ha vā tāni rakṣāgsyādityaṃ yodhayaṃti yāvadastamanvagāttāni ha vā etāni rakṣāgṃsi gāyatriyābhimaṃtritenāṃbhasā śāmyaṃti tadu ha vā ete brahmavādinaḥ pūrvābhimukhāssaṃdhyāyāṃ gāyatriyābhimaṃtritā āpa ūrdhvao vikṣipaṃti tā etā āpo vajrī bhūtvā tāni rakṣāgṃsi maṃdehāruṇe dvīpe prakṣipaṃti yatpadakṣiṇaṃ prakramaṃti tena pāpnānamavadhūnvaṃtyudyaṃtamastaṃyaṃtamādityamabhidhyāya* *nkurvan brāhmaṇo vidvānsa kalaṃ bhadramaśnute 'sāvādityo brahmeti brahmaiva san brahmāpyeti ya evaṃ veda* ‖) (Trai. Ā. 2-2)[?318]

In former times the rākṣasas practised fierce austerity. Then the god Prajāpati appeared before them and asked what boon they wished. They prayed: "Grant us the power and the opportunity to fight with Sūra (the sun)." Prajāpati agreed: "So be it." For that reason the rākṣasas, as soon as the sun rises, begin to fight with him and keep on fighting until his setting. But they can be driven away by water hallowed by the recitation of the Gāyatrī. Therefore the brahmavādins, at the morning twilight (and at the evening twilight too), recite the Gāyatrī and offer arghya with the water so hallowed. These drops of water offered as arghya turn into thunderbolts and hurl the rākṣasas into the island called मंदेहारण (*maṃdehāraṇa*)[?319]. Then the brahmavādins, by worship accompanied by circumambulation and obeisance, shake off their sin. A brāhmaṇa who knows this truth (the knower of Brahman), if he recites the Gāyatrī and offers arghya at sunrise and at sunset, and through this worships and meditates on the Āditya, obtains every kind of good (welfare). The Āditya is the Supreme Brahman. The man who knows that the Āditya, the object of worship of the Gāyatrī[?320], is Brahman, and so worships, attains union with Brahman and becomes of the very form of Brahman. Thus the recitation of the Gāyatrī is praised.

Kannada.

The greatness of the Gāyatrī

The mantra beginning तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*), famous throughout the world and declaring the spiritual aim of man, is renowned as the Gāyatrī. The inspiration of this mantra has spread over the whole earth and has attracted the minds of all seekers of truth in the world. All alike have extolled it as the great mantra that declares the lofty aim of man.

India will never forget the inspiration which the all-knowing great sages taught in the Vedas and Upaniṣads at the dawn of history. Their keen minds, ceaselessly absorbed in the knowledge of reality, were ever engaged in piercing the darkness of tamas and entering the divine radiance. Neither merely personal worldly happiness nor the otherworldly happiness of heaven was their aim. As the great mantra says, धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् (*dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt*), their whole aim lay in the acquisition of knowledge. No aim better than this can exist for man; in such terms they have praised the greatness of the Gāyatrī.

The matter taught by the Gāyatrī mantra is the pursuit of that human goal by which all the actions of life, without the distinction "this is small, this is great, this is low, this is high," become excellent human goals. The supreme goal of life is contained in the pursuit of the Supreme Reality, called by various names such as Ātman, Paramātman, Brahman. For the personality to shine with the light of this vision of harmony and attain fullness, the divine presence of the Lord must be gained in the solitude of meditation. At the time of this meditation the pure intellect of the person should touch the consciousness of the worlds and the unseen worlds, and he should pray that the radiance of that divine consciousness fill him.

तेजोऽसि तेजो मयि धेहि .... ओजोऽसि ओजो मयि धेहि ॥ (*tejo 'si tejo mayi dhehi .... ojo 'si ojo mayi dhehi ‖*)

You who are the radiance of radiance, fill me with radiance. You who are the strength of strength, fill me with might. You are the vigour of all vigour; manifest as vigour in me also. You are the peace of all endurance; arise in my self as that peace of endurance. In this way, at the time of meditation, the seeker of truth, whose aspiration blazes up touching Brahman, and the consciousness which desires peace of the Self and through it peace of the world (ओं द्यौः शांतिरंतरिक्षं शांति: (*oṃ dyauḥ śāṃtiraṃtarikṣaṃ śāṃti:*) ...), prays through the meditation in the form of the mantra भर्गोदेवस्य धीमहि (*bhargò devasya dhīmahi*), धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् (*dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt*).

To say it in sum: the nature of the Gāyatrī is that it praises the reality that teaches universal harmony and is the means to that knowledge of reality. सूर आत्मा जगतस्तस्थुषश्च (*sūra ātmā jagatastasthuṣaśca*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-115-1); योऽसौ तपन्नुदेति । स सर्वेषां भूतानां प्राणानादायोदेति (*yo 'sau tapannudeti | sa sarveṣāṃ bhūtānāṃ prāṇānādāyodeti*) (Tai. Ā. 1-14-1); असावादित्यो

ब्रह्म (*asāvādityo brahma*) (Tai. Ā. 2-2-1). The very same light of the Āditya, the reality and radiance of the Āditya, which is praised in these and similar passages, is praised in the present mantra also. This great Gāyatrī mantra is the means, in the form of meditation, to the realisation of Savitṛ, the Self of the universe, by praising him. The Upaniṣads praise this very thing as the reality of Supreme Brahman. The questions arise naturally: How is it that Savitṛ, the Self of the universe, is the deity who teaches the reality of Supreme Brahman? Is the bhargas of Savitṛ the form of the supreme light of the Supreme Person? How is meditation in the form of the Gāyatrī the chief means of knowing this supreme light? And is it proper to call the Gāyatrī, which is merely a metre, the Supreme Reality named Parabrahman? Therefore it is necessary to examine these matters now.

The purpose of the mantra is to worship by meditation on the bhargas of Savitṛ, who is worthy of worship by the whole world. The reality from which the whole world arises, by whose power all the beings so arisen live, and into which, again, at the time of dissolution the whole world is merged: such Brahman is denoted by the word savitṛ, as stated in the foregoing explanations. It has also been made clear that worship of the Gāyatrī is the chief means for knowing such Brahman-reality. This kind of worship is the very nature of the present mantra तत्सवितुः (*tatsavituḥ*). Sāyaṇa's commentary on this mantra has been quoted above and its purport given. Here the words that are the parts of this mantra are explained on the basis of Śruti passages, and the fruit of meditating on this mantra is also stated. Vidyāraṇya Svāmin has set out the meaning of the Gāyatrī mantra in verse thus:

तदित्यवाङ्मनोगम्यं धैयं यत्तूरमंडले । सवितुः सकलोत्पत्तिस्थितिसंहारकारिणः ॥ वरेण्यमाश्रयणीयं यदाधारमिदं जगत् । भर्गः स्वसाक्षात्कारेणाविद्यातत्कार्यदाहकं ॥ देवस्य द्योतमानस्य ह्यानंदात्क्रीडतोऽपि वा । धीमह्यहं स एवेति तेनैवाभेदसिद्धये ॥ धियोऽंतःकरणवृत्तीश्च प्रत्यक्रवणचारिणीः । य इत्यलिंगधर्मं यत्सत्यज्ञानादिलक्षणं ॥ नोऽस्माकं बहुधाभ्यस्तभिन्नभेददृशां तथा । प्रचोदयात्वेरयतु प्रार्थनेयं विचार्यते ॥ (*tadityavāṅmanogamyaṃ dhaiyaṃ yattūramaṃḍale | savituḥ sakalotpattisthitisaṃhārakāriṇaḥ || vareṇyamāśrayaṇīyaṃ yadādhāramidaṃ jagat | bhargaḥ svasākṣātkāreṇāvidyātatkāryadāhakaṃ || devasya dyotamānasya* *hyānaṃdātkrīḍato 'pi vā | dhīmahyahaṃ sa eveti tenaivābhedasiddhaye ‖ dhiyo 'ṃtaḥkaraṇavṛttīśca pratyakravaṇacāriṇīḥ | ya ityaliṃgadharmaṃ yatsatyajñānādilakṣaṇaṃ ‖ no 'smākaṃ bahudhābhyastabhinnabhedadṛśāṃ tathā | pracodayātverayatu prārthaneyaṃ vicāryate ‖*)

The Supreme Reality, which cannot be reached by speech or mind (यतो वाचो निवर्तंते । अप्राप्य मनसा सह (*yato vāco nivartaṃte | aprāpya manasā saha*)) and which abides in the orb of the sun, is what the word तत् (*tat*) denotes. Because it is the root cause of the origin, continuance and dissolution of all the worlds, this Brahman is denoted by the word सवितृ (*savitṛ*). This Brahman, the support of the whole world, is the most worshipful and honoured place of refuge. Because this divine light, self-luminous and illuminating the world, burns up and destroys the ignorance of the world and its effects such as sorrow, it has the name भर्ग (*bharga*). Because he is luminous and intent on the sport of bliss, Savitṛ has the epithet देवस्य (*devasya*). The meaning of the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) is the meditation of non-difference: "I am this very Brahman who is in the form of Savitṛ." The activities of the inner organ of the individual are what the word धि (*dhi*) denotes. The reality which has the characteristics of truth, knowledge and so on and whose nature is beyond gender is designated by यः (*yaḥ*). The word नः (*naḥ*) points to the individual selves in whom, through the notion of being different from Brahman, the feeling of difference has grown from the beginning. The prayer is that he may impel us, who by the notion of difference appear as different selves, to practise the meditative contemplation that is the means to the realisation of non-difference with Brahman. What scriptural authority there is for the purport stated by Vidyāraṇya must now be examined.

तत् (*tat*)

In the present mantra two kinds of construction are shown for the word तत् (*tat*). Some hold that this word is an epithet of सवितुः (*savituḥ*), others that it is an epithet of भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*). Though there are thus two views in the explanation, in sum the purport of both is the same. How? First: तत् इति षष्ठ्या परिणम्यते तस्येत्यर्थः । (*tat iti ṣaṣṭhyā pariṇamyate tasyetyarthaḥ* |) The meaning तस्य (*tasya*), ending in the sixth case, is reached for the word तत् (*tat*); it means "of that god." Or else तस्य (*tasya*) means ब्रह्मणः (*brahmaṇaḥ*); the word तत् (*tat*) itself denotes Brahman.

ओं तत्सदिति निर्देशः त्रिविधो ब्रह्मणः स्मृतः । (*oṃ tatsaditi nirdeśaḥ trividho brahmaṇaḥ smṛtaḥ* |) (Bha. Gī. 17-23)[?321]

The commentators have made this clear when explaining the word तत् (*tat*) there. Rāmānujācārya says तच्छब्दो हि ब्रह्म वाची प्रसिद्धः । (*tacchabdo hi brahma vācī prasiddhaḥ* |) — the word तत् (*tat*) is well known as denoting Brahman — and Śaṅkarācārya, explaining the meaning of the word, says तत् इति ब्रह्माभिधानं उच्चार्य । (*tat iti brahmābhidhānaṃ uccārya* |) — "having uttered तत् (*tat*), the name that refers to Brahman." In the Upaniṣads the word तत् (*tat*) is used in many places as a synonym of Brahman. For example, the expression तत्त्वमसि श्वेतकेतो (*tattvamasi śvetaketo*) is famous throughout the world: तत् (*tat*) means Brahman, त्वं (*tvaṃ*) means the individual self. It is clear that by तत्त्वमसि (*tattvamasi*) the non-difference of the individual self and Brahman is stated. तत्वदं हि सर्वज्ञं सत्यसंकल्पं जगत्कारणं ब्रह्म परामृशति । तदैक्षत बहु स्यां । इत्यादिषु तस्यैव प्रकृतित्वात् । (*tatvadaṃ hi sarvajñaṃ satyasaṃkalpaṃ jagatkāraṇaṃ brahma parāmṛśati* | *tadaikṣata bahu syāṃ* | *ityādiṣu tasyèva prakṛtitvāt* |) The word तत् (*tat*) points to that Brahman who is all-knowing, of true resolve, the cause of the world; the sentence तदैक्षत (*tadaikṣata*) and the like teach the same. Thus it is explained everywhere. In the Chāndogya, the section beginning तज्जलानिति (*tajjalāniti*) (Chā. U. 3-14-1) is renowned as the "tat-tvam" section[?322]. The sentences ओं तत्पृह । ओं तद्वायुः । ओं तदात्मा (*oṃ tatpṛha* | *oṃ tadvāyuḥ* | *oṃ tadātmā*) and the like teach the same. Therefore, since in the present mantra the word तत् (*tat*) is a synonym of Brahman, it is used as an epithet of Savitṛ, who is of the form of Supreme Brahman. It is one view that the statement that it should be taken to mean तस्य सवितुः (*tasya savituḥ*) is correct.

Secondly, to say that the word तत् (*tat*) is an epithet of भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*) is another view. Bhaṭṭabhāskara, explaining the purport of this mantra in the Taittirīya Āraṇyaka (Tai. Ā. 1-11), says तत्सवितुः इति । व्याख्यातं सं पश्यामि इत्यत्र । (*tatsavituḥ iti* | *vyākhyātaṃ saṃ paśyāmi ityatra* |) — informing us that in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā, in the section beginning

सं पश्यामि (*saṃ paśyāmi*), the explanation of this mantra has been given — and then explains it again. But the explanation given in the Āraṇyaka differs from that given in the Saṃhitā section. In the Āraṇyaka: सवितुः देवस्य प्रेरयितुः तत् तादृशं वरेण्यं भर्गः । (*savituḥ devasya prerayituḥ tat tādṛśaṃ vareṇyaṃ bhargaḥ* |) Of Savitṛ, the impeller of the world

having explained it as "the brilliance of the god, famed in the world and worthy of worship", he has shown that the word तत् (*tat*) is an adjective of the word भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*). He has also stated clearly that the same is explained in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā section. There, however, (it says) आहवनीयमुपतिष्ठते—तत्सवितुरिति गायत्रा । (*āhavanīyamupatiṣṭhate—tatsavituriti gāyatrā* |), and the rule तत्तस्य सुपां सुलुक् (*tattasya supāṃ suluk*) shows that the sixth case ending is elided in the word तत् (*tat*). He has made it plain that the meaning should be taken as तस्य सवितुः (*tasya savituḥ*) (Tai. Saṃ. Bhā. 1-5-6). He has further said that, as in सवितुः देवस्य तदन्नादि धीमहि (*savituḥ devasya tadannādi dhīmahi*), the word तत् (*tat*) may also be an adjective of the word भर्ग (*bharga*), which gives the meaning "food and the like". Although the explanations differ in this way, it may be said that, from the point of view of examining the truth, there is no contradiction between the two.

हिरण्मये परे कोशे विरजं ब्रह्म निष्कलं । तच्छभ्रं ज्योतिषां ज्योतिस्तद्यदात्मविदो विदुः ॥ (*hiraṇmaye pare kośe virajaṃ brahma niṣkalaṃ | tacchabhraṃ jyotiṣāṃ jyotistadyadātmavido viduḥ* ‖) (Mu. U. 2-2-9). In the supreme golden sheath, which is of the nature of the Supreme and is golden, there is Brahman, free from passion and without parts (without distinctions). It is a light-form shining more brightly than the most radiant lights. Only knowers of the Self can know it.

न तत्र सूर्यो भाति न चंद्रतारकं नेमा विद्युतो भांति कुतोऽयमग्नि । तमेव भांतमनुभाति सर्वं तस्य भासा सर्वमिदं विभाति ॥ (*na tatra sūryo bhāti na caṃdratārakaṃ nemā vidyuto bhāṃti kuto 'yamagni | tameva bhāṃtamanubhāti sarvaṃ tasya bhāsā sarvamidaṃ vibhāti* ‖) (Mu U. :-2-18). Before that divine light which is Brahman the sun cannot shine; the light of the moon and the stars cannot shine before it. By its own self-luminosity all radiant lights shine; everything in the world is illumined by that light. In such passages the identity of Brahman and light is stated, showing that one principle is called by two names. Therefore, if the word तत् (*tat*) is an adjective of Savitṛ, it means तस्य जगत्पेरकस्य सवितुः (*tasya jagatperakasya savituḥ*); if it is an adjective of the word भर्ग (*bharga*), it means ब्रह्मरूपस्य सवितुः जगत्पसिद्धं ज्योतिः (*brahmarūpasya savituḥ jagatpasiddhaṃ jyotiḥ*).

सवितुर् (*savitur*)

The derivation of the word Savitṛ, and that the Supreme Brahman itself is what the word Savitṛ denotes, have been stated above. सूते सकलजननिर्वृतिहेतुं वृष्टिं (*sūte sakalajananirvṛtihetuṃ vṛṣṭiṃ*)—one kind of derivation is that the sun is named Savitṛ because he brings forth rain, which gives satisfaction to all the worlds. *sauti sakalaśreyāṃsi

dhātṛṇāṃ savitā*—he is called by this name because he gives all good things to worshippers.* उद्यंतमस्तंयन्तमादित्यमभिध्यायन्नुर्वनाह्मणो विद्वान् सकलं भद्रमश्नुते *(*udyaṃtamastaṃyantamādityamabhidhyāyannurvanāhmaṇo vidvān sakalaṃ bhadramaśnute*)—by meditation on the sun rising and setting, welfare comes to the whole world. Such Śruti passages support the above derivation.

सविता सर्वभूतानां सर्वभावान् प्रसूयते । सवनात् प्रेरणाच्चैव सविता तेन चोच्यते ॥ (*savitā sarvabhūtānāṃ sarvabhāvān prasūyate | savanāt preraṇāccaiva savitā tena cocyate ‖*) (by the Yogin Yājñavalkya). The derivation, "the name Savitṛ is because he is the cause of the birth of the whole world and the impeller of all worldly activities", is found in the Upaniṣads and other works just as in the Saṃhitā passages quoted earlier. This verse as quoted also gives the same explanation. Moreover, the praises of Savitṛ in the Ṛk Saṃhitā are always accompanied by such derivations, and those same praises also explain the meaning of the present mantra.

विश्वा रूपाणि प्रति मुंचते कविः प्रासावीद्भद्रं द्विपदे चतुष्पदे । वि नाकमख्यत्सविता वरेण्योऽनु प्रयाणमुषसो वि राजति ॥ (*viśvā rūpāṇi prati muṃcate kaviḥ prāsāvīdbhadraṃ dvipade catuṣpade | vi nākamakhyatsavitā vareṇyo 'nu prayāṇamuṣaso vi rājati ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-2). The wise Savitṛ bears all the forms of the world within himself. He brings forth welfare for all creatures of the world, two-footed and four-footed. He is the impeller of all living powers. Therefore he is the most choiceworthy. By this quality he illumines the world. This description praises Savitṛ in the same way as Brahman is praised in the Upaniṣad words quoted above, तस्य भासा सर्वमिदं विभाति (*tasya bhāsā sarvamidaṃ vibhāti*).

उतेशिषे प्रसवस्य त्वमेक इदुत पूषा भवसि देव यामभिः । उतेदं विश्वं भुवनं वि राजसि श्यावाश्वस्ते सवितः स्तोममानशे ॥ (*uteśiṣe prasavasya tvameka iduta pūṣā bhavasi deva yāmabhiḥ | utedaṃ viśvaṃ bhuvanaṃ vi rājasi śyāvāśvaste savitaḥ stomamānaśe ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-5).

तत्सवितुर्वृणीमहे वयं देवस्य भोजनं । श्रेष्ठं सर्वधातमं तुरं भगस्य धीमहि ॥ (*tatsaviturvṛṇīmahe vayaṃ devasya bhojanaṃ | śreṣṭhaṃ sarvadhātamaṃ turaṃ bhagasya dhīmahi ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-82-1).

Savitṛ is the lord of all worldly activities, the protector of the whole world. He bears all beings within himself. He is the cause of all creation, preservation and dissolution. "We wish to know the greatness of such Savitṛ, the lord of the world." Since Savitṛ's own nature is thus praised, it is known that Savitṛ is

the Supreme Deity who rules the world. Upaniṣad passages such as देवाय सवित्रे सत्यप्रसवाय (*devāya savitre satyaprasavāya*) (Bṛ. U. 6-5-19) state this nature clearly.

युंजानः प्रथमं मनस्तत्त्वाय सविता धियः । अग्नोर्ज्योतिर्निचाय्य पृथिव्या अध्याभरत् ॥ (*yuṃjānaḥ prathamaṃ manastattvāya savitā dhiyaḥ | agnorjyotirnicāyya pṛthivyā adhyābharat ‖*) (Śve. U. 2-1). Savitṛ, the impeller of consciousness, first with a restrained mind obtained the intellect whose nature is the impulse of truth. Then he made the light in the form of fire spread over the earth. Therefore युंजते मन उत युंजते धियो विप्रा विप्रस्य बृहतो विपश्चितः (*yuṃjate mana uta yuṃjate dhiyo viprā viprasya bṛhato vipaścitaḥ*). The order of worship is thus taught: to realise the divine light of Savitṛ, the cause of the world, one should contemplate it with a restrained mind in the form of meditation. The divine nature of this Savitṛ, the cause of the world, has been explained above.

वरेण्यं (*vareṇyaṃ*).

वरेण्यं पुरुषार्थकामिभिर्वर्णीयं । श्रेष्ठं वा । (*vareṇyaṃ puruṣārthakāmibhirvarṇīyaṃ | śreṣṭhaṃ vā* |) Since all human goals are obtained only through Savitṛ's grace, and since he is the most excellent as a form of light, he is highly esteemed by the world. सत्यात्म प्राणारामं मन आनंदं । शांतिसमृद्धममृतं । (*satyātma prāṇārāmaṃ mana ānaṃdaṃ | śāṃtisamṛddhamamṛtaṃ* |) The Supreme Brahman whose Self is truth, whose breath is a place of delight, whose mind is the abode of bliss, and who is rich in peace—such a Supreme Self is esteemed by the world; therefore श्रोतव्यो मंतव्यो निदिध्यासितव्यः (*śrotavyo maṃtavyo nididhyāsitavyaḥ*): he is to be heard, to be reflected upon, and to be meditated upon; thus he is praised.

भर्गः (*bhargaḥ*).

The choiceworthy light of Savitṛ is what the word Bharga denotes: अविद्यातत्कार्ययोर्भर्जनाद्भर्गः स्वयंज्योतिः परब्रह्मात्मकं तेजः । (*avidyātatkāryayorbharjanādbhargaḥ svayaṃjyotiḥ parabrahmātmakaṃ tejaḥ* |) Because it destroys ignorance and its fruits, sin and sorrow, the supreme light of the Supreme Brahman is known as Bharga. The meaning of this word is given in the Maitrī Upaniṣad as follows.

अथ भर्गा इति यो ह वा अमुष्मिन्नादित्ये निहितस्तारकोऽक्षिणि वैष भर्गाख्यो भाभिर्गतिरस्य हीति भर्गो भर्जयतीति वैष भर्गा इति रुद्रो ब्रह्मवादिनोऽथ भ इति भासयतीमान् लोकान् र इति रंजयतीमानि भूतादि ग इति गच्छंत्यस्मिन्नागच्छंत्यस्मादिमाः प्रजास्तस्माद्भरगत्वाद्भर्गः ॥ शश्वत् सूयमानात् सूर्यः सवनात् सविता .... ॥ (*atha bhargā iti yo ha vā amuṣminnāditye nihitastārako 'kṣiṇi vaiṣa bhargākhyo bhābhirgatirasya hīti bhargo bharjayatīti vaiṣa bhargā iti rudro brahmavādino 'tha bha iti bhāsayatīmān lokān ra iti raṃjayatīmāni bhūtādi ga iti gacchaṃtyasminnāgacchaṃtyasmādimāḥ prajāstasmādbharagatvādbhargaḥ* ‖ *śaśvat sūyamānāt sūryaḥ savanāt savitā ....* ‖) (Mai. U. 6-2).

What Savitṛ's Bharga is must be examined. अथ य एषोऽंतरक्षिणि पुरुषो दृश्यते (*atha ya eṣo 'ṃtarakṣiṇi puruṣo dṛśyate*)—the light that shines within the sun shines also as light in the eye of the person, as praised in the Chāndogya and other texts (Chā. U. 1-7-5); that light is what is called Bharga.

1. भाभिः किरणैरधिष्ठानधर्मैरस्य गतिर्गमनं विषयव्याप्तिरस्य इति व्युत्पत्तेर्भर्ग इत्येकं निर्वचनं (*bhābhiḥ kiraṇairadhiṣṭhānadharmairasya gatirgamanaṃ viṣayavyāptirasya iti vyutpatterbharga ityekaṃ nirvacanaṃ*)—भाः (*bhāḥ*) means a ray endowed with brilliance. Because there is movement in the form of such rays, and because from this movement there is all-pervasiveness, the sun's radiance is named Bharga: this is one kind of derivation.
2. Secondly, भर्जयति जगत् संहरतीति रुद्रो भर्ग इति (*bharjayati jagat saṃharatīti rudro bharga iti*)—it is the view of the Brahmavādins that Rudra is named Bharga because he destroys the world.
3. Thirdly, भकाररेफगकाराणां प्रत्येकनिर्वचनं । (*bhakārarephagakārāṇāṃ pratyekanirvacanaṃ* |) भासयति तेजोमंडलांतर्गतचित्पकाशेन इमान् सर्वानेव लोकान् इति भ इत्युच्यते । (*bhāsayati tejomaṃḍalāṃtargatacitpakāśena imān sarvāneva lokān iti bha ityucyate* |) इमानि भूतानि स्थावरजंगमात्मकानि प्राणानुगतचिदानंदात्मना रंजयति प्रीणयति सुखात्मकं करोति इति र उच्यते । (*imāni bhūtāni sthāvarajaṃgamātmakāni prāṇānugatacidānaṃdātmanā raṃjayati prīṇayati sukhātmakaṃ karoti iti ra ucyate* |) अस्मिन् सर्वकारणात्मनि सुषुप्तिप्रळययोः सर्वा इमा प्रजाः गच्छंति लयं प्राप्पुवंति तथा प्रभोधसृष्टोरस्मादेवागच्छंत्याविर्भवंतीति ग इत्युच्यते ॥ (*asmin sarvakāraṇātmani suṣuptipraḷayayoḥ sarvā imā prajāḥ gacchaṃti layaṃ prāppuvaṃti tathā prabhodhasṛṣṭorasmādevāgacchaṃtyāvirbhavaṃtīti ga ityucyate* ||)

A separate derivation can be given for each of the three letters bha, ra, ga. Thus: 1) because it makes all the worlds shine by its brilliance, it is called bha. 2) Because it delights all beings, moving and unmoving, with its own nature of consciousness-bliss, and gives them happiness, it is called ra. 3) And because in deep sleep and at dissolution all beings are absorbed in Supreme Brahman, the cause of all, and again at awakening and at creation come forth from Brahman alone, it is called ga. Since the Supreme Brahman is thus the combination and harmony of bha, ra and ga, he is named Bharga; so the derivations of this word are stated.

It has been stated above that the word Bharga is given other meanings such as Savitṛ's brilliance or food. भर्गः, तेजः, अन्नं, धनं (*bhargaḥ, tejaḥ, annaṃ, dhanaṃ*)—the word Bharga has the meaning brilliance, food or wealth; any of these meanings may be taken. The commentary of Bhaṭṭabhāskara on the Taittirīya Saṃhitā has also been quoted above and explained (Tai. Saṃ. Bha. Bhā. 1-5-6).

भृजः साकेभवेद्धातुर्यस्मात् पाचयते ह्यसौ । भ्राजते दीप्यते यस्मात् जगदंते हरत्यपि ॥ (*bhṛjaḥ sāke bhaveddhāturyasmāt pācayate hyasau | bhrājate dīpyate yasmāt jagadaṃte haratyapi ‖*)

कालाग्नि रूपमास्थाय सर्पार्चिः सप्तरश्मिभिः । भ्राजते तत्स्वरूपेण तस्माद्भर्गः स उच्यते ॥ (*kālāgni rūpamāsthāya sarpārciḥ saptaraśmibhiḥ | bhrājate tatsvarūpeṇa tasmādbhargaḥ sa ucyate ‖*) (Yogi-Yājñavalkya). Because he ripens the world, and at the end of time destroys it, and, assuming the form of the fire of time, shines with seven rays, the name Bharga is well known. भेति भासयते लोकान् । रेति रंजयते प्रजाः । ग इत्यागच्छतेजस्रं भरगो भर्ग उच्यते (*bheti bhāsayate lokān | reti raṃjayate prajāḥ | ga ityāgacchatejasraṃ bharago bharga ucyate*)—in this explanation too, as in the Maitrī Upaniṣad passage above, the combination and harmony of the powers of Brahman called Savitṛ, indicated by the letters bha, ra, ga, are stated.

देवस्य (*devasya*).

देवो द्युलोकवर्तित्वाद्देवनाद्देवनेन वा । (*devo dyulokavartitvāddevanāddevanena vā |*) Savitṛ is denoted by the word देव (*deva*) because he dwells in the heavenly world, because he is shining, or because his nature is playful.

दीव्यते क्रीडते यस्माद्रोचते द्योतते दिवि । तस्माद्द्देव इति प्रोक्तः स्तूयते सर्वदेवतैः ॥ (*dīvyate krīḍate yasmādrocate dyotate divi | tasmādddeva iti proktaḥ stūyate sarvadevataiḥ ‖*). By the greatness through which this god Savitṛ plays in the world that is his sport, and is a giver of delight to this world by his play, and by which he shines radiant in the heavenly world—by that very greatness the epithet "deva" is established for him. Or: दीव्यति नंदतीति देवः । अखंडानंदैकरस इत्यर्थः । (*dīvyati naṃdatīti devaḥ | akhaṃḍānaṃdaikarasa ityarthaḥ* |) This epithet is because he is always in the bliss that is play, and because he is of the nature of bliss itself. Śaṅkarācārya also says देवस्येति सर्वद्योतनात्मताखंडचिदेकरसं । (*devasyeti sarvadyotanātmatākhaṃḍacidekarasaṃ* |)—it is the designation of the principle that illumines everything, is indivisible, and is of the nature of bliss.

अन्नोऽन्तर आत्मानंदमयः । तेनैष पूर्णः । .... तस्य प्रियमेव शिरः । मोदो दक्षिणः पक्षः । प्रमोद उत्तरं पक्षः । आनंद आत्मा ॥ (*anno 'ntara ātmānaṃdamayaḥ | tenaiṣa pūrṇaḥ | .... tasya priyameva śiraḥ | modo dakṣiṇaḥ pakṣaḥ | pramoda uttaraṃ pakṣaḥ | ānaṃda ātmā* ‖) (Tai. U. 2-5). The meaning stated is that the special quality of Supreme Brahman, who is described as this blissful Person, endowed with the wings of joy and delight and himself of the nature of bliss, is what the word देव (*deva*) denotes. In ब्रह्मजज्ञं देवमीड्यं विदित्वा (*brahmajajñaṃ devamīḍyaṃ viditvā*) (Ka. U. 1-17) and similar places also this meaning is given to the word देव (*deva*). Passages such as आत्मरतिः आत्मक्रीड (*ātmaratiḥ ātmakrīḍa*) and यस्य विश्व उपासते (*yasya viśva upāsate*) also praise this quality.

धीमहि (*dhīmahi*)

For the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) the meanings ध्यायामः (*dhyāyāmaḥ*) and मनसा धारयामः (*manasā dhārayāmaḥ*) are given. Or one may also say ध्येयतया धारयामः (*dhyeyatayā dhārayāmaḥ*). Thus both meanings, meditation and holding, are stated: let us hold him in the mind in the form of meditation. The benefit and necessity of meditation have been stated above. Supreme Brahman, who cannot be reached by speech or mind, is not within the range of speech and mind; therefore realisation must be attained only through worship in the form of meditation. The order of realisation in this meditation is also prescribed: धीमह्यहं स एवेति तेनैवाभेदसिद्धये (*dhīmahyahaṃ sa eveti tenaivābhedasiddhaye*). The word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) conveys the holding in meditation by which the individual soul, which held the separate idea that it is different from Supreme Brahman, knows itself to be Brahman and attains realisation of unity.

बुध्यादिसर्वदृश्यसाक्षिलक्षणं यन्ने स्वरूपं तत्सर्वाधिष्ठानभूतं परमानंदं निरस्तसमस्तानर्थरूपं स्वप्रकाशचिदात्मकं ब्रह्मेत्येवं धीमहि ध्यायेम । (*budhyādisarvadṛśyasākṣilakṣaṇaṃ yanne svarūpaṃ tatsarvādhiṣṭhānabhūtaṃ paramānaṃdaṃ nirastasamastānartharūpaṃ svaprakāśacidātmakaṃ brahmetyevaṃ dhīmahi dhyāyema* |) Śaṅkarācārya explains the meaning of the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*) thus: that inner Self of mine which is the witness of the entire visible world beginning with the intellect, and that Self-principle which is the substratum of all the worlds, of the nature of supreme bliss, removing all evil, self-luminous, and called Brahman—by meditating on it as Brahman, there is realisation of Brahman. He has also said that this meditation is of the nature of knowledge of oneness with Brahman. It was said before that Savitṛ's light is named Bharga because it destroys faults such as ignorance; the same is the fruit of the meditation indicated by the word धीमहि (*dhīmahi*).

अहं विश्वं भुवनमभ्यभवां । सुवर्ण ज्योतीः । (*ahaṃ viśvaṃ bhuvanamabhyabhavāṃ* | *suvarṇa jyotīḥ* |) (Tai. U. 3-8). "I have overcome all the worlds, which are diverse, and having attained realisation of Brahman, the supreme light, I have become Brahman itself": the means, in the form of meditation, for the coming of such a feeling of unity is here extolled. As the fruit of this meditation, which is knowledge: मर्त्योऽमृतो भवत्यत्र ब्रह्म समश्नुते (*martyo 'mṛto bhavatyatra brahma samaśnute*)—the mortal man gains immortality and here itself attains realisation of Brahman. As the sun shines in the sky, he too shines with the divine brilliance that is Brahman.

धियः (*dhiyaḥ*)

To obtain knowledge of oneness with Brahman, the knowledge that is its means and the action that brings about that knowledge are absolutely necessary. The prayer is that Savitṛ may impel such a धी (*dhī*). Here two kinds of meaning may be given to the word धी (*dhī*):

intellect or insight, or action. Since ignorance must be destroyed, insight is necessary. This insight comes only through action in the form of worship,

...is attainable. Therefore both meanings are appropriate. Moreover, since meditation is itself a form of praise of Savitṛ, it would not be wrong to take the word धी (*dhī*) as "praise." Good works are the means to knowledge of Brahman. Action preceded by special knowledge is itself also a form of praise. This identity, or concomitance, of knowledge and action is stated in the Taittirīya Upaniṣad as follows.

विज्ञानं यज्ञं तनुते । कर्माणि तनुतेऽपि च । विज्ञानं देवास्सर्वे ब्रह्म ज्येष्ठमुपासते । (*vijñānaṃ yajñaṃ tanute | karmāṇi tanute 'pi ca | vijñānaṃ devāssarve brahma jyeṣṭhamupāsate |*) (Tai. U. 2-1)

One who has special knowledge performs the sacrifice. Because the agency consists in such knowledge, there is the understanding that the Self made of knowledge is Brahman. But in order to realise the Brahman made of bliss, who surpasses the Brahman made of knowledge, meditation in the form of action grounded in knowledge is indispensable. So the word धी (*dhī*), comprising knowledge, action and meditation, here denotes meditation that is preceded by knowledge and is of the nature of action. The prayer is that He impel us to such meditation.

यः (*yaḥ*)

यः सविता सूरः (*yaḥ savitā sūraḥ*): one meaning is "the Brahman in the form of Savitṛ, who exists, may impel us." Or else यः (*yaḥ*) is a change of gender: यद्भर्गो धियः प्रचोदयात् । तत् ध्यायेम (*yadbhargo dhiyaḥ pracodayāt | tat dhyāyema*) is the construction. That is, "let us meditate on that Bharga, the light of the Sun, which impels our action preceded by knowledge", another meaning expressing the aspiration. Thus Sāyaṇa has shown two constructions. There is also a view that यः (*yaḥ*), by change of gender, may indicate the inner Brahman itself. Mādhava states it thus: य इत्यलिंगदर्मं यत्सत्यज्ञानादिलक्षणं (*ya ityaliṃgadarmaṃ yatsatyajñānādilakṣaṇaṃ*); the purport is that the Supreme Brahman itself should impel our thought. तस्य

यच्छब्दनिर्दिष्टस्यात्मनः स्वरूपभूतं परं ब्रह्म तत्सवितुरित्यादिसद्यैः निर्दिष्टते (*tasya yacchabdanirdiṣṭasyātmanaḥ svarūpabhūtaṃ paraṃ brahma tatsavituriyādisadyai: nirdiṣṭate*): the Supreme Brahman that is the very nature of the Self is indicated by "tat savituḥ" and the rest. Thus Śaṅkarācārya gives the word यः (*yaḥ*) a meaning referring to the Supreme Brahman.[?323]

नः (*naḥ*)

नः (*naḥ*) means "to us." The notion "Brahman is one, we the individual selves are another, we are finite" creates a sense of difference between Brahman and the individual selves. But this sense of difference has grown naturally in man and is not easily removed. In truth there is no difference of any kind between the Supreme Self and the individual selves, yet the sense of difference grows out of the ignorance natural to man.

Therefore, regarding the individual selves as standing apart from Brahman, the prayer is made: "Grant to us, who are different from you, the intellect that impels to good works and is the means of worshipping you."

प्रचोदयात् (*pracodayāt*)

प्रचोदयात् । प्रेरयेत् (*pracodayāt | prerayet*): may He impel the good intellect that produces good works. The prayer is that, through action preceded by knowledge, He give the power to know Savitṛ's Bharga. One important point must be noted in this prayer: the main point is that without the grace of God the fruit of knowledge cannot be obtained.

मय्यासक्तमनाः पार्थ योगं युंजन् मदाश्रयः । असंशयं समग्रं मां यथा ज्ञास्यसि तच्छृणु ॥ (*mayyāsaktamanāḥ pārtha yogaṃ yuṃjan madāśrayaḥ | asaṃśayaṃ samagraṃ māṃ yathā jñāsyasi tacchṛṇu ||*) (Bha. Gī. 7-1)[?324]

ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ! (*jyāyasī cetkarmaṇaste matā buddhirjanārdana !*) When Arjuna asked, "If knowledge is the highest of all, why do you urge me to action?", Kṛṣṇa explains that knowledge without action has no value. But the action must take this form: one must offer the whole intellect to God, be absorbed in Him, take refuge in Him and so obtain God's grace as its fruit. Otherwise mere knowledge is of no use, he answers. The gist is that even the most learned cannot attain success by himself without God's grace.

मया प्रसन्नेन तवार्जुनेदं रूपं परं दर्शितमात्मयोगात् । (*mayā prasannena tavārjunedaṃ rūpaṃ paraṃ darśitamātmayogāt |*) (Bha. Gī. 11-47)

"My form, of divine light, became visible to you only through my grace": here it is taught that realisation of God is impossible without God's grace. The same matter is stated clearly in the Upaniṣads and elsewhere.

नायमात्मा प्रवचनेन लभ्यः न मेधया न बहुना श्रुतेन ॥ यमेवैष वृणुते तेन लभ्यस्तस्येष आत्मा विवृणुते तनूं स्वां ॥ (*nāyamātmā pravacanena labhyaḥ na medhayā na bahunā śrutena ‖ yamevaiṣa vṛṇute tena labhyastasyeṣa ātmā vivṛṇute tanūṃ svāṃ* ‖) (Kar. 2-23)[?325]

This Supreme Self is not to be obtained by discourse, nor by the power of intellect, nor by much hearing of scripture. He is obtained only by the grace of the Supreme Self on whom one relies and whose grace one wins.

Whoever wins such grace, to him the Supreme Self unveils His own body: thus the necessity of God's grace is taught. As in the Īśa Upaniṣad:

आग्ने नय सुपधा राये अस्मान् विश्वानि देव वयुनानि विद्वान् । युयोध्यस्यज्जुहुराणमेनो भूयिष्ठां ते नमउक्तिं विधेम ॥ (*āgne naya supadhā rāye asmān viśvāni deva vayunāni vidvān | yuyodhyasyajjuhurāṇameno bhūyiṣṭhāṃ te namauktiṃ vidhema ‖*) (Īśa. 18)

"O Agni, you who know all actions, give us good intellect and lead us on the good path": as God's grace is prayed for there, so in the present Ṛk too the prayer is: make known to us the knowledge that is the means of knowing God's Bharga, and the action that is of its nature and is service of God; and give us the power to practise it and so worship God.

Grammar (Vyākaraṇa-prakriyā)

- सवितुः—षु प्रसवैश्वर्ययोः धातु. अथवा षूज् प्राणिगर्भविमोचने. कर्तृर्थदल्लि तृच् प्रत्यय आर्धधातुकस्येड्वल्वादेः ऎंबुदरिंद अदक्के इडागम. प्रत्यय निमित्तवागि धातुविन उकारक्के गुण, अवादेश. सवितृशब्द. षष्ठि एकवचनांतरूप. प्रत्यय चित्तादुदरिंद चितः ऎंबुदरिंद अंतोदात्तस्वर बरुत्तदॆ.
- वरेण्यं—वृञ् वरणे. धातु- वृञ् एण्यः (उ. सू. ३७८) ऎंबुदरिंद एण्य प्रत्यय. अर्धधातुकवादुदरिंद इदन्नु निमित्तीकरिसि धातुविन ऋकारक्के सार्वधातुकार्थधातुकयोः ऎंबुदरिंद गुण. ऋकारद स्थानक्के बरुवुदरिंद रपरवागि बरुत्तदॆ. द्वितीया एकवचनांतरूप.
- भर्गः—भ्रस्थ पाके धातु. सर्वधातुभ्य आसन् ऎंबुदरिंद असुन् प्रत्यय. भ्रस्टो रोपधयोरमन्यतरस्यां (पा. सू. ६-४-४७) भस्वधातुसंबंधियाद रेफक्कू उपधॆगू लोपवू समागमवू बरुत्तदॆ ऎंबुदरिंद इल्लि रमागम. इदु मित्तादुदरिंद मिदचोंत्यात्परः ऎंबुदरिंद अंत्याचिन परवागि बरुत्तदॆ. न्यंक्वादिगणदल्लि इदन्नु पाठमाडुवुदरिंद जकारक्के कुत्वदिंद गकारादेश. प्रत्यय नित्तादुदरिंद आद्युदात्तस्वर बरुत्तदॆ.
- देवस्य—दिवु क्रीडादिषु धातु. नंदिग्रहपचादिभ्यः ऎंबुदरिंद पचादिसतितवादुदरिंद अच् प्रत्यय. अदन्नु निमित्तीकरिसि धातुविन लघूपधॆगॆ गुण. चितः ऎंबुदरिंद अंतोदात्तस्वर बरुत्तदॆ. षष्ठी एकवचनांतरूप.
- धीमहि—ध्यै चिंतायां धातु. लिज् उत्तमपुरुषबहुवचनदल्लि व्यत्ययदिंद आत्मनेपदद महिज् प्रत्यय. बहुलं छंदसि ऎंबुदरिंद धातुविन यकारक्के संप्रसारण (इकारादेश) संप्रसारणाच्च ऎंबुदरिंद पूर्वरूप. हलः ऎंबुदरिंद संप्रसारणक्के दीर्घ. अथवा धीज् आधारे धातु. चित्तादुदरिंद आत्मनेपदी. हिंदिनंतॆ लिजिनल्लि बहुलं छंधसि ऎंबुदरिंद विकरण प्रत्ययक्के लुक्. अतिजंतद परदल्लि बंदिरुवुदरिंद तिजंतनिघातस्वर बरुत्तदॆ.
- धियः—ध्यै चिंतायां धातु. ध्यायतेः संप्रसारणंच (वा. २-५१) ऎंबुदरिंद क्विप् प्रत्यय. अदरॊडनॆ धातुविन यकारक्के संप्रसारण. पूर्वरूप. हलः ऎंबुदरिंद दीर्घ. धी शब्द. धातुस्वर बरुत्तदॆ. द्वितीयाबहुवचनदल्लि शस्प्रत्यय. अचिश्नुधातु—ऎंबुदरिंद धातुविन इकारक्के इयजादेश. प्रत्ययसकारक्के रुत्व. विसर्ग.
- प्रचोदयात्— प्र उपसर्ग. चुद प्रेरणे. धातु. लेट् प्रथमपुरुष एकवचनदल्लि तिप् प्रत्यय. इकारलोप. लेटोडाटौ ऎंबुदरिंद आडागम. चुरादियल्लि पठितवादुदरिंद धातुविगॆ स्वार्थदल्लि णिच्. अदक्के गुण, अयादेश. यः ऎंबुदर संबंधविरुवुदरिंद यद्वृत्तान्नित्यं ऎंबुदरिंद निघातस्वर निषेध बरुत्तदॆ. आगमा अनुदात्ताः ऎंबुदरिंद आडागम अनुदात्तवागुवुदरिंद णिच् प्रत्ययस्वरदिंद दकारोत्तराकारवु उदात्तवागुत्तदॆ. तिजि चोदात्तवति ऎंबुदरिंद उदात्तविशिष्टतिजंतपरवादुदरिंद गतिगॆ (प्र) अनुदात्तस्वर बरुत्तदॆ.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

दे॒वस्य॑ सवि॒तुर्व॒यं वा॑ज॒यन्त॒ः पुरं॑ध्या ।
भग॑स्य रा॒तिमी॑महे ॥ ११ ॥

> *devasya saviturvayaṃ vājayantaḥ puraṃdhyā |*
> *bhagasya rātimīmahe ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> देवस्य । सवितुः । वयं । वाजयंतः । पुरंध्या ।
> भगस्य । रातिं । ईमहे ॥ ११ ॥

> *devasya | savituḥ | vayaṃ | vājayaṃtaḥ | puraṃdhyā |*
> *bhagasya | rātiṃ | īmahe ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वाजयंतो वाजमन्नमात्मन इच्छंतो वयं देवस्य द्योतमानस्य सवितुः
> पुरंध्या तद्विषयस्तुत्या प्रज्ञया वा भगस्य भजनीयस्य धनस्य रातिं दानमीमहे ।
> याचामहे ॥ रातिं । मंत्रे वृषेत्यादिना क्तन उदात्तत्वं ॥

> *vājayaṃto vājamannamātmana icchaṃto vayaṃ devasya dyotamānasya savituḥ*
> *puraṃdhyā tadviṣayastutyā prajñayā vā bhagasya bhajanīyasya dhanasya rātiṃ dānamīmahe |*
> *yācāmahe ‖ rātiṃ | maṃtre vṛṣetyādinā ktana udāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

We, desiring *vājaṃ*, food for ourselves, ask (ईमहे (*īmahe*), "we beg") the gift (रातिं (*rātiṃ*)) of the wealth worthy to be shared (भगस्य (*bhagasya*)), of the shining (देवस्य (*devasya*)) Savitṛ, by praise (पुरंध्या (*puraṃdhyā*)) addressed to him, or by intelligence.

Word-to-word meaning

- वाजयंतः (*vājayaṃtaḥ*)—desirous of obtaining food
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we

- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of the shining
- सवितुः (*savituḥ*)—Savitṛ
- पुरंध्या (*puraṃdhyā*)—by intelligence in the form of praise
- भगस्य (*bhagasya*)—of the venerable wealth
- रातिं (*rātiṃ*)—the gift
- ईमहे (*īmahe*)—we ask

Gist

We, desirous of food, ask for the gift of venerable wealth from the shining Savitṛ, by intelligence in the form of praise.

English translation

Desirous of food, we solicit with praise, of the divine Savitri, the gift of affluence.

Special Topics

पुरंध्या (*puraṃdhyā*)—तद्विषयस्तुत्या प्रज्ञया वा (*tadviṣayastutyā prajñayā vā*): by praise concerning Savitṛ, or by intelligence. पुरंधिर्बहुधीः (*puraṃdhirbahudhīḥ*): one with abundant intellect may be called Purandhi. The authors of the Nirukta, asking who such a deity is, give the purport together with an etymology of this word (Ni. 6-13). Since the word धी (*dhī*) is listed among the names of action, this epithet may also indicate a special quality of Indra. In places such as पुराणी देवि युवतिः पुरंधि (*purāṇī devi yuvatiḥ puraṃdhi*) (3-60-1) it has been explained earlier as "possessing much praise." It may be said that the word is used here to show the abundance of praise or intelligence in the present mantra. The special meanings and usages of this word were given earlier in this same volume, in the special topics of Ṛk 3-61-1 (Ṛ. Saṃ.).

देवस्य (*devasya*)—द्योतमानस्य (*dyotamānasya*): of the shining Savitṛ.

दीव्यते क्रीडते यस्माद्रोचते द्योतते दिवि । तस्माद्भाव इति प्रोक्तः स्तूयते सर्वदेवतैः ॥ (*dīvyate krīḍate yasmādrocate dyotate divi | tasmādbhāva iti proktaḥ stūyate sarvadevataiḥ ||*) (Yogiyājña verse 3)[?326]

By whatever power he sports in the world through playful resolve and action, and by whatever greatness he shines radiant in the heavenly world, for that reason Savitṛ is denoted by the word "deva": thus the importance of the epithet is explained.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

दे॒वं नर॑ः सवि॒तारं॒ विप्रा॑ य॒ज्ञैः सु॑वृ॒क्तिभि॑ः ।
न॒म॒स्यन्ति॑ धि॒येषि॒ताः ॥ १२ ॥

> *devaṃ naraḥ savitāraṃ viprā yajñaiḥ suvṛktibhiḥ |*
> *namasyanti dhiyeṣitāḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> देवं । नरः । सवितारं । विप्राः । यज्ञैः । सुवृक्तिभिः ।
> नमस्यंति । धिया । इषिताः ॥ १२ ॥

> *devaṃ | naraḥ | savitāraṃ | viprāḥ | yajñaiḥ | suvṛktibhiḥ |*
> *namasyaṃti | dhiyā | iṣitāḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> नरः कर्मणां नेतारो विप्रा मेधाविनोऽध्वय्यादयो धियेषिताः
> कर्मणा बुद्ध्या वा प्रेयमाणाः संतः सवितारं देवं त्वां यज्ञैर्यजनीयैर्हविर्भिः सुवृक्तिभिः
> शोभनस्तोत्रैश्च नमस्यंति । परिचरंति ॥ नमस्यंति । नमोवरिवश्चित्रजः क्यजिति क्यच् ॥

> *naraḥ karmaṇāṃ netāro viprā medhāvino 'dhvayyādayo dhiyeṣitāḥ*
> *karmaṇā buddhyā vā preyamāṇāḥ saṃtaḥ savitāraṃ devaṃ tvāṃ*
> *yajñairyajanīyairhavirbhiḥ suvṛktibhiḥ śobhanastotraiśca namasyaṃti |*
> *paricaraṃti ‖ namasyaṃti | namovarivaścitrajaḥ kyajiti kyac ‖*

Summary

The नरः (*naraḥ*), leaders of rites, and the विप्राः (*viprāḥ*), the wise adhvaryus and others, धियेषिताः (*dhiyeṣitāḥ*), impelled by action or by intellect, serve (नमस्यंति (*namasyaṃti*), "they attend on") you, the god Savitṛ, with sacrifices, that is, offerings fit for sacrifice, and with good praises.

Word-to-word meaning

- नरः (*naraḥ*)—leaders of rites
- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—the wise adhvaryus and others
- धियेषिताः (*dhiyeṣitāḥ*)—impelled by intelligence
- देवं (*devaṃ*)—who are of divine nature
- सवितारं (*savitāraṃ*)—and of the form of Savitṛ, you
- यज्ञैः (*yajñaiḥ*)—with offerings fit for sacrifice
- सुवृक्तिभिः (*suvṛktibhiḥ*)—with excellent praises
- नमस्यंति (*namasyaṃti*)—they serve

Gist

O Savitṛ, the adhvaryus and others, leaders of rites and wise, impelled by their intelligence, serve you, who are of divine nature and of the form of Savitṛ, with offerings fit for sacrifice and with excellent praises.

English translation

Devout and wise men, impelled by intelligence, adore the divine Savitri with sacrifices and sacred hymns.

Special Topics

Suvṛktibhiḥ—the word सुवृक्ति (*suvṛkti*) means an excellent hymn of praise. One may say that it is formed from the root वृज् (*vṛj*) preceded by सु (*su*). In places such as नासत्याभ्यां बर्हिरिव प्र वृंजे (*nāsatyābhyāṃ barhiriva pra vṛṃje*) the root (वृज् (*vṛj*), वृंज् (*vṛṃj*)) has the sense "cuts", yet the purport is given as "procure"; in the same way the word सुवृक्ति (*suvṛkti*) too may be taken to mean something excellently constructed, something procured. Ordinarily the word सुवृक्ति (*suvṛkti*) is used only as a synonym of "hymn". The sense "purify by cutting" is natural to it. For example, just as in places such as दधिध्वे व्यक्तबर्हिषः (*dadhidhve vyaktabarhiṣaḥ*) (1-38-1) the purport is that the darbha grass is cut properly and purified, so here too the meaning is a hymn constructed with purified words; that is, the purport is a sacred and venerable hymn.

Some scholars show the derivation of this word as सु (*su*) + ऋक्ति (*ṛkti*) and explain it as an excellent hymn. For example, the scholar Monier Williams, in his Sanskrit English Dictionary, explains su-ṛkti as su- + ṛc, ṛc preceded by su, meaning an excellent hymn consisting of ṛks, and states that the derivation should be shown in the way su-ita becomes suvita. But in places such as नमोव्यक्ति (*namovyakti*) the derivation namaḥ + ṛc is not valid.

इहेहैषां कृणुहि भोजनानि ये बर्हिषो नमोवृक्तिं न जग्मुः (*ihehaiṣāṃ kṛṇuhi bhojanāni ye barhiṣo namovṛktiṃ na jagmuḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-131-2)

In such places the word नमस् (*namas*) is explained as food or praise, and the word व्यक्ति (*vyakti*) as avoidance. It is shown to be formed from the root वृज् (*vṛj*) and used in the sense of cutting, and the purport in the quoted ṛk is that a cutting of praise does not occur. On the basis of such examples there is no difficulty in saying that the present word su-vyakti also is formed from the root वृज् (*vṛj*). Hymns made by choosing words suited to the occasion and refining them in poetic praises are what the word सुवृक्ति (*suvṛkti*) denotes.

That example of नमोव्यक्ति (*namovyakti*) is taken only to show that the word व्यक्ति (*vyakti*) in it is formed from the root वृज् (*vṛj*); the purport of the two words is not the same. Or else, there is room to say that even where this word is used in the sense of avoidance, the meaning is still an excellent hymn. For example—

अग्निः न स्ववृक्तिभिर्होतारु त्वा वृणीमहे (*agniḥ na svavṛktibhirhotāru tvā vṛṇīmahe*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-1-1)

Here, in the word स्वव्यक्ति (*svavyakti*), the word स्व (*sva*) is explained as स्वयंकृताभिः (*svayaṃkṛtābhiḥ*)—made by oneself—and व्यक्तिभिः (*vyaktibhiḥ*) as दोषवर्जिताभिः (*doṣavarjitābhiḥ*)—separated from faults. The purport is "(we choose you) with hymns made by oneself and free of faults, hence excellent"; so in the present case too, सुवृक्तिभिः (*suvṛktibhiḥ*) may be explained as "with hymns that are excellent and, being free of faults, superior".

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सोमो॑ जिगाति गा॒तुवि॒द्देवाना॑मेति निष्कृ॒तम् ।
ऋ॒तस्य॒ योनि॑मा॒सद॑म् ॥ १३ ॥

> *somo jigāti gātuviddevānāmeti niṣkṛtam |*
> *ṛtasya yonimāsadam ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सोमः । जिगाति । गात्वुविश् । देवानां । ऐति । निःकृतं ।
> यतस्य । योनिं । आसवं ॥ १३ ॥

> *somaḥ | jigāti | gātvuviś | devānāṃ | aiti | niḥkṛtaṃ |*
> *yatasya | yoniṃ | āsavaṃ ‖ 13 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्निषोमप्रणयने सोमो जिगातीत्याद्यास्ति स ऋचः । सूत्रितं च ।
> सोमो जिगाति गातुविद्देवानां तमस्य राजा वरुणस्तमश्विनेत्यर्धर्च आरमेत् ।
> आ. ४–१८ इति ॥
> गातुवित् गातुर्वेदिमार्गः तं जानानः सोमो जिगाति । गच्छति । गंतव्यं
> स्थानं दर्शयति । देवानां संबंधि निष्कृतं संस्कृतमासदं सर्वैरासदनीयमृतस्य
> यज्ञस्य योनिं स्थानं हविर्धानाख्यमेशि । प्राप्नोति ॥ जिगाति । गा स्तुतौ । जुहोत्यादिः ॥

> *agniṣomapraṇayane somo jigātītyādyāsti sa ṛcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *somo jigāti gātuviddevānāṃ tamasya rājā varuṇastamaśvinetyardharca āramet |*
> *ā. 4-18 iti ‖*
> *gātuvit gāturvedimārgaḥ taṃ jānānaḥ somo jigāti | gacchati | gaṃtavyaṃ*
> *sthānaṃ darśayati | devānāṃ saṃbaṃdhi niṣkṛtaṃ saṃskṛtamāsadaṃ*

> *sarvairāsadanīyamṛtasya*
> *yajñasya yoniṃ sthānaṃ havirdhānākhyameśi* | *prāpnoti* ‖ *jigāti* | *gā*
> *stutau* | *juhotyādiḥ* ‖

Summary

In the Agniṣoma-praṇayana, the seven ṛks beginning सोमो जिगाति (*somo jigāti*) are used; and it is prescribed in the sūtra: सोमो जिगाति गातुविद्देवानां तमस्य राजा वरुणस्तमश्विनेत्यर्धर्च आरमेत् (*somo jigāti gātuviddevānāṃ tamasya rājā varuṇastamaśvinetyardharca āramet*) (Ā. 4-18). Soma, who knows the gātu (the path to the altar), goes; he goes and shows the place to be reached. He reaches the place of the sacrifice (ṛta), called the havirdhāna, which belongs to the gods, is prepared, and is to be occupied by all.?327

Word-to-word meaning

- गातुनित् (*gātunit*)—knowing his place to be reached
- सोमः (*somaḥ*)—Soma
- जिगाति (*jigāti*)—goes and reaches
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—that which is to belong to the gods
- निष्कृतं (*niṣkṛtaṃ*)—well prepared
- असदं (*asadaṃ*)—

having a seat for the gods

- ऋतस्य योनिं (*ṛtasya yoniṃ*)—as the womb of the sacrifice (in the form of the havirdhāna)
- एति (*eti*)—is transformed into

Gist

Knowing the place he is to reach, Soma reaches the sacrificial altar, which is the seat of the gods and well prepared, and is offered to the gods in the form of the oblation.

English translation

Soma, knowing the right path, proceeds (by it) : he goes to the excellent seat of the gods, the place of sacrifice.

Special Topics

In the Agniṣoma-praṇayana rite, these three ṛks beginning सोमो जिगाति (*somo jigāti*) are to be recited for the first three ṛks to be recited at that time, as explained by the Āśvalāyana-śrauta-sūtra: सोमो जिगाति गातुविद्देवानां तमस्य राजा वरुणस्तमश्विनेत्यर्धर्च आरमेत् (*somo jigāti gātuviddevānāṃ tamasya rājā varuṇastamaśvinetyardharca āramet*) (Ā. 4-10).

Gātuvit—the word गातु (*gātu*) means the place to be reached; it also means the path to be gone. This place to be reached is the sacrificial place on earth; this is the path of performance. (It may also be the path of going to the world of the gods.) Here it is explained as the path leading to the sacrificial altar. That this word is also used in the senses of house, hymn, etc., was stated earlier (Ṛgveda-saṃhitā, Part 11, p. 503).

ऋतस्य योनिं एति (*ṛtasya yoniṃ eti*)—यज्ञस्य स्थानं हविर्धानाख्यं प्राप्नोति (*yajñasya sthānaṃ havirdhānākhyaṃ prāpnoti*). The purport is that he reaches the sacrificial place called the havirdhāna. Hence here the word गातु (*gātu*) means the womb of ṛta. It was stated earlier that the word योनि (*yoni*) too has meanings such as house, place of origin, and the chief place called Veda. Here it is explained as the chief place called havirdhāna. The pavilion built separately for placing Soma, the chief implement of the Soma sacrifice, is called havirdhāna. Or this name is also well known for the cart that brings the Soma oblation.

यदस्मिन्मोहो भवति हविर्वै देवानागं् सोमस्तस्माद्धविधानं नाम (*yadasminmoho bhavati havirvai devānāgṃ somastasmāddhavidhānaṃ nāma*) (Śa. Brā. 3 5-3-2)

The Śatapatha-brāhmaṇa gives its purport thus: since Soma, the oblation of the gods, is placed in it, it is called havirdhāna. The Soma-carrier may be the cart that brings the Soma, or the chief place where it is placed.

यज्ञं वा एतत्संभरंति यत्सोमक्रयणै पदं यज्ञमुखगं् हविर्धाने यर्हि हविर्धाने प्राची प्रवर्तयेयुः ॥ (*yajñaṃ vā etatsaṃbharaṃti yatsomakrayaṇai padaṃ yajñamukhagṃ havirdhāne yarhi havirdhāne prācī pravartayeyuḥ ||*) (Tai. Saṃ. 3-1-3-1)

In this description—the havirdhānas are the mouths of the sacrifice; when they are moved forward, oil is to be put on their axles—it is clear that they are carts bringing the Soma. Bhaṭṭabhāskara, explaining the purport of this word, says हवींषि निधीयंते अनयोरिति हविर्धाने शकटे (*havīṃṣi nidhīyaṃte anayoriti havirdhāne śakaṭe*)—the name is because oblations are placed in these—as in the sentence quoted above. Whether the cart that carries Soma or the pavilion built separately to place it, both hold the chief implement of the sacrifice; so the havirdhāna that designates them is well known as the mouth of the sacrifice. In many places this havirdhāna is also used figuratively and contains a profound hidden meaning.

पुरुषो वाव यज्ञः.... .... (*puruṣo vāva yajñaḥ.... ....*) (Chā. U. 3-16-1) "The person himself is the sacrifice." Thus in the Chāndogya and others there is a description showing the identity of the limbs of the person with the limbs that are the implements of the sacrifice. Explaining this very point, the Śatapatha-brāhmaṇa says:

पुरुषो वै यज्ञः .... शिर एवास्य हविर्धानं । (*puruṣo vai yajñaḥ .... śira evāsya havirdhānaṃ |*)

मुखमेवास्याहवनीयः ....। उदरमेवास्य सदः.... ....। (*mukhamevāsyāhavanīyaḥ ....| udaramevāsya sadaḥ.... ....|*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-5-3-1 to 24)

As the head is the chief limb of a person, so for the sacrifice, which is of the form of a person, the havirdhāna is chief. The āhavanīya is the mouth; the sadas is the belly; and so on—thus the chief place of the havirdhāna is declared. In many places the pair of carts is specified as the havirdhāna, and it holds a most venerable position.

प्रेतां यज्ञस्य कंभुवा युवामिदा वृणीमहे । अग्निं च हव्यवाहनं ॥ (*pretāṃ yajñasya kaṃbhuvā yuvāmidā vṛṇīmahe | agniṃ ca havyavāhanaṃ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-41-19)

आ नामुपस्थमद्रुहा देवाः सीदंतु यज्ञियाः । इहाद्य सोमपीतये ॥ (*ā nāmupasthamadruhā devāḥ sīdaṃtu yajñiyāḥ | ihādya somapītaye ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-41-21)

In such ṛks both havirdhānas are described as bringing comfort to the sacrifice and as free of hostility. But what is the havirdhāna here? It may be the pair of carts, or it may be heaven and earth. हविर्धाने अनसी तद्रूपे द्यावापृथिव्यौ वा (*havirdhāne anasī tadrūpe dyāvāpṛthivyau vā*): when the two carts that carry the oblation are decorated,

there is a practice of reciting the very mantras that praise heaven and earth while offering them ointment and the like. Heaven and earth themselves are also addressed as havirdhānas. The praise of these at the time of decorating them is stated in the Aitareya-brāhmaṇa thus:

हविर्धानाभ्यां प्रोह्यमाणाभ्यामनुब्रूहीत्याहाध्वर्युः । (*havirdhānābhyāṃ prohyamāṇābhyāmanubrūhītyāhādhvaryuḥ |*) (I. Brā. 1-29)

When the Soma carts called havirdhāna are being brought forward, the Adhvaryu gives the order, "Recite the mantra that praises them." Then the Hotṛ recites some ṛk mantras and praises them. The first of them is:

युजे वां ब्रह्म पूर्व्यं नमोभिर्वि श्लोक एतु पथ्येव सूरेः । (*yuje vāṃ brahma pūrvyaṃ namobhirvi śloka etu pathyeva sūreḥ |*)

शृण्वंतु विश्वे अमृतस्य पुत्रा आ ये धामानि दिव्यानि तस्थुः ॥ (*śṛṇvaṃtu viśve amṛtasya putrā ā ye dhāmāni divyāni tasthuḥ ||*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-13-1)

He recites: "Reciting the ancient mantra, I fill you with the venerable oblation. May your sound reach the gods. May all the sons of the immortal Prajāpati hear your sound."

ब्रह्मणा ना एते देवा आयुंजत यद्धविर्धाने ब्रह्मणैवैने एतद्युंक्तेन वै ब्रह्मण्वद्रिष्यति ॥ (*brahmaṇā nā ete devā āyuṃjata yaddhavirdhāne brahmaṇaivaine etadyuṃkte na vai brahmaṇvadriṣyati ||*)[?328]

"O carts, in the past the gods yoked you reciting this very ancient mantra. Even now the same course is followed. No trouble approaches the person through this recitation." Then he recites the mantras praising heaven and earth beginning "प्रेतां यज्ञस्य.... (*pretāṃ yajñasya....*)". But what is the connection between the praise of the havirdhāna and the praise of heaven and earth?

द्यावापृथिवी वै देवानां हविर्धाने आस्तां ते उ एवाद्यापि हविर्धाने ते हीदमंतरेण सर्वं हविर्यदिदं किं च तस्मात्तृचं द्यावापृथिवीयमन्वाह ॥ (*dyāvāpṛthivī vai devānāṃ havirdhāne āstāṃ te u evādyāpi havirdhāne te hīdamaṃtareṇa sarvaṃ haviryadidaṃ kiṃ ca tasmāttṛcaṃ dyāvāpṛthivīyamanvāha* ‖)

Heaven and earth were the havirdhānas of the gods; even now they are the same. In them all oblations are contained. Therefore the triplet addressed to heaven and earth is to be recited: "प्रेतां यज्ञस्य.... (*pretāṃ yajñasya....*)", "द्यावा नः पृथिवी.... (*dyāvā naḥ pṛthivī....*)", "आ वा मुपस्थमद्रुहा.... (*ā vā mupasthamadruhā....*)" (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-41-19 to 28) — these three are the triplets to be recited at this time.

Continuing the same praise, Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-13-2 is recited and the praise runs thus:

यमे इव यतमाने यदैतमिति यमे इव हैते यतमाने प्रबाहुगितः॥ (*yame iva yatamāne yadaitamiti yame iva haite yatamāne prabāhugitaḥ*‖)

"You two come together, like twin girls born of one womb, striving alike for the benefit of the world."

प्र वां भरन्मानुषा देवयंत इति देवयंतो ह्येने मानुषाः प्रभरंति ॥ (*pra vāṃ bharanmānuṣā devayaṃta iti devayaṃto hyene mānuṣāḥ prabharaṃti* ‖)

"O havirdhānas, for the benefit of the world for which you come together, the priests and the sacrificer bring you forward."

आसीदतं स्वमु लोकं विदाने स्वासस्थे भवतमिंदवे न इति सोमो वै राजेंदुः सोमाय्वैवैने एतद्राज्ञ आसदेचीक्लृपत् ॥ (*āsīdataṃ svamu lokaṃ vidāne svāsasthe bhavatamiṃdave na iti somo vai rājeṃduḥ somāyvaivaine etadrājña āsadecīklṛpat* ‖)

"O havirdhānas, knowing your own separate place, be seated. Be well-guarded supports for our Soma. Since Soma is king, these two seats are prepared for him to sit." Thus he praises, and then, reciting Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-83-3, praises thus:

अधि द्वयोरदधा उक्थ्यं वच इति द्वयोर्ह्येतत्तृतीयं छदिरधि निधीयते, उक्थ्यं वच इति यदाह यज्ञियं वै कर्मोक्ष्यं वचो यज्ञमेवैतेन समर्धयति । यतस्रुचा मिथुना या सपर्यतः । असंयत्तो व्रते ते क्षेति पुष्यतीति । यदेवादः पूर्वं यत्तवत्पदमाह तदेवैतेन शांत्या शमयति । भद्रा शक्तिर्यजमानाय सुन्वत इत्याशिषमाशास्त्रे ॥ (*adhi dvayoradadhā ukthyaṃ vaca iti dvayorhyetattṛtīyaṃ chadiradhi nidhīyate, ukthyaṃ vaca iti yadāha yajñiyaṃ vai karmokṣyaṃ vaco* *yajñamevaitena samardhayati | yatasrucā mithunā yā saparyataḥ | asaṃyatto vrate te kṣeti puṣyatīti | yadevādaḥ pūrvaṃ yattavatpadamāha tadevaitena śāṃtyā śamayati | bhadrā śaktiryajamānāya sunvata ityāśiṣamāśāstre ||*)

The uktha is placed upon two chadis. The chadi is the covering built around in the form of a house, for placing the Soma on the carts called havirdhāna. Having built two such chadis over the two havirdhānas, a third is placed over the two; this is the order. This is indicated in the Taittirīya also by the sentences दंडो वा औदुंबरस्त्रीयस्य हविर्धानस्य.... (*daṃḍo vā auduṃbarastrīyasya havirdhānasya....*). The order arises because the third chadi is set on the two. Since the uktha itself is of the nature of sacrificial action, by the recitation उक्थं वचः (*ukthaṃ vacaḥ*) or by such ritual acts the sacrifice is brought to completion without obstacle. Therefore: "In both havirdhānas, where barley, oblation and grains are placed together in vessels such as the camasa and offered together for your worship, you have set the mantra in the form of uktha." The sacrificer who keeps havirdhānas thus purified by mantras is occupied in the rite addressed to you without the trouble of fighting enemies. He obtains wealth such as cattle and sons, and in the sacrifice

for you, that sacrificer who presses the Soma for you attains auspiciousness and his strength increases; it is for this reason that the prayer has been made.

विश्वारूपाणि प्रतिमुंचते कविरिति विश्वरूपामन्वाह स रराट्यामीक्षमाणोऽनुब्रूयात् विश्वमिव हि रूपं रराट्याः शुक्लमिव च कृष्णमिव च विश्वं रूपमवरुंध आत्मने च यजमानाय च यत्रैवं विद्वानेतां रराट्यामीक्षमाणोऽन्वाह ॥ (*viśvārūpāṇi pratimuṃcate kaviriti viśvarūpāmanvāha sa rarāṭyāmīkṣamāṇo 'nubrūyāt viśvamiva hi rūpaṃ rarāṭyāḥ śuklamiva ca kṛṣṇamiva ca viśvaṃ rūpamavaruṃdha ātmane ca yajamānāya ca yatraivaṃ vidvānetāṃ rarāṭyāmīkṣamāṇo 'nvāha ||*)

One should recite the mantra विश्वारूपाणि (*viśvārūpāṇi*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 5-81-2) while looking at the rarāṭī. (The garland of darbha grass that is tied at the eastern doorway when the Havirdhāna shed is built is called rarāṭī.) In this garland some of the blades are dry and others are green. Because there are thus various colours, the recitation of the mantra विश्वा रूपाणि (*viśvā rūpāṇi*) while looking at the rarāṭī in this way gives the sacrificer the power to obtain every form.

परि त्वा गीर्वणो गिर इत्युत्तमया परिदधाति। स यदैव हविर्धाने संपरिश्रिते मन्येताथ परिदध्यात् । अनग्नंभावुका ह होतुश्च यजमानस्य च भार्या भवंति यत्रैवं विद्वान्तय्या हविर्धानयोः संपरिश्रितयोः परिदधाति । यजुषा वा एते सं परिश्रियेते यद्धविर्धाने यजुषैवैने एतत्परि श्रयंति ॥ (*pari tvā gīrvaṇo gira ityuttamayā paridadhāti| sa yadaiva havirdhāne saṃpariśrite manyetātha paridadhyāt | anagnaṃbhāvukā ha hotuśca yajamānasya ca bhāryā bhavaṃti yatraivaṃ vidvāntayyā havirdhānayoḥ saṃpariśritayoḥ paridadhāti | yajuṣā vā ete saṃ pariśriyete yaddhavirdhāne yajuṣaivaine etatpari śrayaṃti ‖*)

He concludes by reciting the final mantra परि त्वा गिर्वणो गिरः (*pari tvā girvaṇo giraḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-10-12). May these words of praise, made by us, come to you from every side, encompass you and give you delight; and from this may delight and increase of life come to us as well — this is the purport of the mantra. The Hotṛ should bring his action to an end immediately after the act of covering the two Havirdhānas. If this covering is accomplished without obstruction, then the wives of the Hotṛ and of the sacrificer will also be clothed; there is no occasion for them to be naked. The covering is to be done by reciting the Yajus mantra विष्णो रराटमसि विष्णोः पृष्ठमसि (*viṣṇo rarāṭamasi viṣṇoḥ pṛṣṭhamasi*) (Tai. Saṃ. 1-2-13). In this way the nature of the Havirdhānas and the rites of consecration are described.

एतद्वै देवानां निष्केवल्यं यद्ध विधानं तस्मात्तत्र नाश्नंति न भक्षयंति ॥ (*etadvai devānāṃ niṣkevalyaṃ yaddha vidhānaṃ tasmāttatra nāśnaṃti na bhakṣayaṃti ‖*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-6-1-23)

Since the Havirdhāna belongs wholly to the gods, eating, drinking and the like are forbidden here; thus its sanctity is declared. And,

शिर एवास्य हविर्धानं । वैष्णवं देवतयाथ यदस्मिन्मो भवति हविर्वै देवानां सोमस्तस्माद्धविर्धानं नाम ॥ (*śira evāsya havirdhānaṃ | vaiṣṇavaṃ devatayātha yadasminmo bhavati havirvai devānāṃ somastasmāddavirdhānaṃ nāma ‖*)

(Śa. Brā. 3-5-3-2)

Therefore the Havirdhāna is the head of the Puruṣa who is the sacrifice itself. Because Soma is contained wholly in it, and because Soma himself is of the form of Viṣṇu, it has Viṣṇu as its deity. Because

Soma, the oblation of the gods, is in it, the name Havirdhāna became established for it; thus the Havirdhāna is praised. That Soma attained the designation Havirdhāna is the purport, in the Ṛk under discussion, of the sentence ऋतस्य योनिं एति (*ṛtasya yoniṃ eti*).

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सोमो॑ अ॒स्मभ्यं॑ द्वि॒पदे॒ चतु॑ष्पदे च प॒शवे॑ ।
अ॒न॒मी॒वा इष॑स्करत् ॥ १४ ॥

> *somo asmabhyaṃ dvipade catuṣpade ca paśave |*
> *anamīvā iṣaskarat ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सोमः । अस्मभ्यं । द्विपदे । चतुःपदे । च । पशवे ।
> अनमीवाः । इषः । करत् ॥ १४ ॥

> *somaḥ | asmabhyaṃ | dvipade | catuḥpade | ca | paśave |*
> *anamīvāḥ | iṣaḥ | karat ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोमः स्तोतृभ्योऽस्मभ्यं तथा द्विपदेऽस्मदीयाभ्यो द्विपाद्भ्यः प्रजाभ्यशतुष्पदे पशवे
> चतुष्पाद्द्यो गवादिपशुभ्यश्चानमीवा रोगवर्जितानीषोऽन्नानि
> करत् । करोतु ॥ चतुष्पदे । भसंज्ञायां पादस्य पद्भावः । इसुसोः सामर्थ्य इति
> संहितायां सत्वं । आदेशप्रत्यययोरिति षत्वं । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः । करत् ।
> करोतेर्लेट्ट्यडागमः । इषस्करदित्यत्र संहितायां कःकरत्करतीत्यादिना सत्वं ॥

> *somaḥ stotṛbhyo 'smabhyaṃ tathā dvipade 'smadīyābhyo dvipādbhyaḥ*
> *prajābhyaśatuṣpade paśave catuṣpāddyo gavādipaśubhyaścānamīvā*
> *rogavarjitānīṣo 'nnāni*
> *karat | karotu ‖ catuṣpade | bhasaṃjñāyāṃ pādasya padbhāvaḥ |*
> *isusoḥ sāmarthya iti*
> *saṃhitāyāṃ satvaṃ | ādeśapratyayayoriti ṣatvaṃ | bahuvrīhau*

> *pūrvapadasvaraḥ | karat |*
> *karoterlèṭṭyaḍāgamaḥ | iṣaskaradityatra saṃhitāyāṃ*
> *kaḥkaratkaratītyādinā satvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Soma is to make food free of disease (अनमीवा (*anamīvā*), "without sickness") for us the singers; likewise for our two-footed creatures, our offspring, and for the four-footed beasts, cows and the rest. करत् (*karat*) is "let him make". The rest of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- सोमः (*somaḥ*)—Soma
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—to us, the singers
- द्विपदे (*dvipade*)—to our sons and the like
- चतुष्पदे (*catuṣpade*)—four-footed
- पशवे च (*paśave ca*)—and to our animals as well
- अनमीवाः (*anamīvāḥ*)—free of disease
- इषः (*iṣaḥ*)—food
- करत् (*karat*)—let him provide

Gist

May Soma provide food free of disease to us the singers, to our sons and the like, and to our four-footed animals as well.

English translation

May Soma grant to us and to (our) biped and quadruped animals, wholesome food.

Special Topics

अनमीवाः (*anamīvāḥ*)—अम-रोगे (*ama-roge*). The word अमीवा (*amīvā*) is formed from the word अम (*ama*), which gives the meaning "disease". The epithet अमीवाहा (*amīvāhā*), "destroyer of disease", of Indra and other deities gives in many places also the meaning "destroyer of enemies". Here too, for the word अनमीवाः (*anamīvāḥ*) both meanings, "free of disease" and "free of enemies", are possible.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्माक॒मायु॑र्व॒र्धयं॑न्न॒भिमां॑ती॒ः सहं॑मानः ।
सोमं॑ः स॒धस्थ॒मासं॑दत् ॥ १५ ॥

> *asmākamāyurvardhayannabhimātīḥ sahamānaḥ |*
> *somaḥ sadhasthamāsadat ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्माकं । आयुः । वर्धयन् । अभिमातीः । सहमानः ।
> सोमः । सधस्थं । आ । असदत् ॥ १५ ॥

> *asmākaṃ | āyuḥ | vardhayan | abhimātīḥ | sahamānaḥ |*
> *somaḥ | sadhasthaṃ | ā | asadat ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स सोमो देवोऽस्माकमायुरन्नं जीवनं वा वर्धयन्तृद्धिं प्रापयन्नभिमातीः कर्मविघ्नकारिणः शत्रून् सहमानोऽभिभवन्नस्माकं सधस्थं हविर्धानाख्यं
> स्थानमासदत् । आसीदतु ॥ असदत् । सदेर्लेटि रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *sa somo devo 'smākamāyurannaṃ jīvanaṃ vā vardhayantṛddhiṃ prāpayannabhimātīḥ karmavighnakāriṇaḥ śatrūn sahamāno 'bhibhavannasmākaṃ sadhasthaṃ havirdhānākhyaṃ sthānamāsadat | āsīdatu ‖ asadat | saderleṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

That god Soma, increasing our life (आयुः (*āyuḥ*)), which may be food or living, that is, bringing it to growth, and overcoming the अभिमातीः (*abhimātīḥ*), the enemies who obstruct the rite, is to take his seat in our सधस्थं (*sadhasthaṃ*), the place called Havirdhāna. आसदत् (*āsadat*) means "let him sit". The rest is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- सोमः (*somaḥ*)—the god Soma
- अस्माकं (*asmākaṃ*)—our

- आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—life
- वर्धयन् (*vardhayan*)—increasing
- अभिमातीः (*abhimātīḥ*)—the enemies who cause us harm
- सहमानः (*sahamānaḥ*)—striking and driving away
- सधस्थं (*sadhasthaṃ*)—on the sacrificial altar
- आसदत् (*āsadat*)—let him come and take his place

Gist

May the god Soma, increasing our life and striking down and driving away the enemies who cause us harm, come and sit on the sacrificial altar.

English translation

May Soma, prolonging our lives and overcoming our adversaries, sit down in our place of sacrifice.

Special Topics

अभिमातिः (*abhimātiḥ*)—अभितः हिंसतीत्यभिमातिः (*abhitaḥ hiṃsatītyabhimātiḥ*). The meaning is an enemy who harms from all around. There is no rule that the one who harms must be an enemy.

पाप्मा ना अभिमातिरिंद्रमेवाभिमातिहनग् स्वेन भागधेयेनोपधावति ॥ (*pāpmā nā abhimātiriṃdramevābhimātihanag svena bhāgadheyenopadhāvati* ‖)

(Tai. Saṃ. 2-1-3-5)

Sin is the enemy. Indra himself destroys this enemy that is of the nature of sin. From sentences such as this it is understood that the word अभिमाति (*abhimāti*) is also used in the senses "sin" or "most sinful".

सधस्थं (*sadhasthaṃ*)—Here the word सधस्थ (*sadhastha*) has been explained as the place called Havirdhāna. Any place in which all are gathered together may be what is meant. In some places it is explained as a synonym of the atmosphere: सहस्थानं लोकत्रयाशयभूतमंतरिक्षं (*sahasthānaṃ lokatrayāśayabhūtamaṃtarikṣaṃ*). The place in the form of the altar where all the priests gather is also called सदस्य (*sadasya*).

कुह स्विद्दोषा कुह वस्तोरश्विना कुहाभिपित्वं करतः कुहोषतुः । को नां शयुत्रा विधवेव देवरं मर्यं न योषा कृणुते सदस्य आ ॥ (*kuha sviddoṣā kuha vastoraśvinā kuhābhipitvaṃ karataḥ kuhoṣatuḥ | ko nāṃ śayutrā vidhaveva devaraṃ maryaṃ na yoṣā kṛṇute sadasya ā ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-40-2)

In this passage Sāyaṇa has taken the word सधस्थ (*sadhastha*) to mean a place in the form of the altar, while the author of the Nirukta takes it to mean a dwelling in the form of a house where all live together. Likewise for the word त्रिषधस्थः (*triṣathasthaḥ*) too (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-12-2 and elsewhere) the meaning given is लोकेषु सहावस्थानं (*lokeṣu sahāvasthānaṃ*). *sahasthānaṃ

puṇyakṛtāṃ sahanivāsayogyaṃ bhūrādilokasaptakaṃ* — in some places it is explained as the seven worlds, Bhū and the rest, in which the virtuous can dwell together; and उत्तरं उकृष्टतरं सर्वेषां लोकानां उपरिभूतं सहस्थानं सत्यलोकं (*uttaraṃ ukṛṣṭataraṃ sarveṣāṃ lokānāṃ uparibhūtaṃ sahasthānaṃ satyalokaṃ*) — in some places as Satyaloka, which lies above all the worlds and is the best of all. In the Ṛk under discussion the meaning is either the place in the form of the sacrificial altar or the place called Havirdhāna.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ नो॑ मित्रावरुणा घृ॒तैर्गव्यू॑तिमुक्षतम् ।
मध्वा॒ रजां॑सि सुक्रतू ॥ १६ ॥

> *ā no mitrāvaruṇā ghṛtairgavyūtimukṣatam |*
> *madhvā rajāṃsi sukratū ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । नः । मित्रावरुणा । धृतैः । गव्यूतिं । उक्षतं ।
> मध्वा । रजांसि । सुक्रतू इति सुक्रतू ॥ १६ ॥

> *ā | naḥ | mitrāvaruṇā | dhṛtaiḥ | gavyūtiṃ | ukṣataṃ |*
> *madhvā | rajāṃsi | sukratū iti sukratū ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्निष्टोमे प्रातःसवने मैत्रावरुणशस्त्र आ नो मित्रावरुणेति स्तोत्रियस्तृचः । सूत्रितं च । आ
> नो मित्रावरुणा नो गंतं रिशादसा । आ. ५–१० । इति ॥
> चतुर्विंशेऽहनि प्रातःसवने मैत्रावरुणे शस्त्र आ नो मित्रावरुणेति षडहस्तोत्रियसंज्ञकस्तृचः ।
> सूत्रितं च । आ ने ६ मित्रावरुणा मित्रं वयं हवामहे । आ. ७–२ ।
> इति ॥ स्तोमवृद्धावयमेव तृच आवापार्थः । सूत्रितं च । आ नो मित्रावरुणेति
> तृचौ । आ. ७–५ । इति ॥ दाक्षायणे यज्ञे द्वे अमावास्ये कर्तव्ये । तत्रोत्तरस्याममावास्यायां
> द्वितीयेऽहनि मैत्रावरुण आ नो मित्रावरुणेति तस्यानुवाक्या ।
> सूत्रितं च । आ नो मित्रावरुणा यद्वंहिष्ठं नातिविधे सुदाना । आ. २–१४ । इति ॥
> सुक्रतू शोभनकर्माण् हे मित्रावरुण् नोऽस्माकं गव्यूतिं गवां मार्गं
> गोनिवासस्थानं धृतैः क्षरणसाधनैः पयोधिरोक्षतं । समंतात्सिंचतं । अस्मभ्यं
> दोग्धिर्गाः प्रयच्छतमिति भावः । रजांस्यस्मदावासस्थानानि मध्वा मधुररसेन

> *agniṣṭome prātaḥsavane maitrāvaruṇaśastra ā no mitrāvaruṇeti*
> *stotriyastṛcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | ā no mitrāvaruṇā no gaṃtaṃ riśādasā | ā.*
> *5-10 | iti ‖*
> *caturviṃśe 'hani prātaḥsavane maitrāvaruṇe śastra ā no mitrāvaruṇeti*
> *ṣaḍahastotriyasaṃjñakastṛcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | ā nè 6 mitrāvaruṇā*
> *mitraṃ vayaṃ havāmahe | ā. 7-2 |*
> *iti ‖ stomavṛddāvayameva tṛca āvāpārthaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | ā no*
> *mitrāvaruṇeti*
> *tṛcau | ā. 7-5 | iti ‖ dākṣāyaṇe yajñe dve amāvāsyè kartavye |*
> *tatrottarasyāmamāvāsyāyāṃ dvitīye 'hani maitrāvaruṇa ā no*
> *mitrāvaruṇeti tasyānuvākyā |*
> *sūtritaṃ ca | ā no mitrāvaruṇā yadbhaṃhiṣṭhaṃ nātividhe sudānā | ā.*
> *2-14 | iti ‖*
> *sukratū śobhanakarmāṇ he mitrāvaruṇ no 'smākaṃ gavyūtiṃ gavāṃ*
> *mārgaṃ*
> *gonivāsasthānaṃ dhṛtaiḥ kṣaraṇasādhanaiḥ payodhirokṣataṃ |*
> *samaṃtātsiṃcataṃ | asmabhyaṃ*
> *dògdhirgāḥ prayacchatamiti bhāvaḥ | rajāṃsyasmadāvāsasthānāni*
> *madhvā madhurarasena*

> सिंचतं ॥ गव्यूतिं । गोर्यूत् छंदसीति वांतादेशः । मध्वा। सर्वविधीनां छंदसि
> विकल्पितत्वादत्र नुमागमाभावः ॥

> *siṃcataṃ ‖ gavyūtiṃ | goryūt chaṃdasīti vāṃtādeśaḥ | madhvā|*
> *sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi*
> *vikalpitatvādatra numāgamābhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

In the Agniṣṭoma, at the morning pressing, in the Maitrāvaruṇa's śastra, the tṛca beginning आ नो मित्रावरुण (*ā no mitrāvaruṇa*) is the stotriya tṛca. It is prescribed in the sūtra आ नो मित्रावरुणा नो गंतं रिशादसा (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā no gaṃtaṃ riśādasā*) (Ā. 5-10). On the twenty-fourth day, at the morning pressing, in the Maitrāvaruṇa's śastra, the tṛca beginning आ नो मित्रावरुण (*ā no mitrāvaruṇa*) is the one called the ṣaḍaha-stotriya; the sūtra is आ नें ६ मित्रावरुणा मित्रं वयं हवामहे (*ā nè 6 mitrāvaruṇā mitraṃ vayaṃ havāmahe*) (Ā. 7-2). For the increase of the stoma the same tṛca is the one to be inserted (āvāpa); the sūtra is आ नो मित्रावरुणेति तृचौ (*ā no mitrāvaruṇeti tṛcau*) (Ā. 7-5). In the Dākṣāyaṇa sacrifice two new-moon rites are to be performed; in the later new moon, on the second day, the Maitrāvaruṇa's anuvākyā is आ नो मित्रावरुणे (*ā no mitrāvaruṇe*) [the Ṛk beginning आ नो मित्रावरुण (*ā no mitrāvaruṇa*)]; the sūtra is आ नो मित्रावरुणा यद्भंहिष्ठं नातिविधे सुदाना (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā yadbhaṃhiṣṭhaṃ nātividhe sudānā*) (Ā. 2-14).

Explanation: O सुक्रतू (*sukratū*), doers of good works, O Mitra and Varuṇa, नः (*naḥ*) our गव्यूतिं (*gavyūtiṃ*), the path of the cows, the place where the cows dwell, उक्षतं (*ukṣataṃ*), sprinkle all around with घृतैः (*dhṛtaiḥ*), the means of flowing, that is, with milk; the sense is: give us cows that yield milk. रजांसि (*rajāṃsi*), our dwelling places, sprinkle with मध्वा (*madhvā*), sweet juice

The block completes the sentence: "sprinkle" (सिंचतं (*siṃcataṃ*)). The rest of the block is grammar (the forms गव्यूतिं (*gavyūtiṃ*) and मध्वा (*madhvā*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- सुक्रतू (*sukratū*)—O you two who are doers of excellent works
- मित्रावरुणा (*mitrāvaruṇā*)—O Mitra and Varuṇa

- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- गव्यूतिं (*gavyūtiṃ*)—the dwelling place of the cows
- धृतैः (*dhṛtaiḥ*)—with waters
- आ उक्षतं (*ā ukṣataṃ*)—fill completely
- रजांसि (*rajāṃsi*)—all the worlds
- मध्वा (*madhvā*)—with sweet juice (fill)

Gist

O Mitra and Varuṇa, doers of excellent works, fill the dwelling place of our cows completely with milk and the like. Fill all the worlds with sweet juice.

English translation

Mitra and Varuna, sprinkle our cow-stalls with butter ; performers of of good works, (sprinkle) the worlds with honey.

Special Topics

In the morning pressing of the Agniṣṭoma sacrifice, when the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa recites the śastra mantras, the three Ṛks beginning आ नो मित्रावरुणा (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā*) (Ṛks 16–18 of this sūkta) are to be recited as the stotriya tṛca; this is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, आ नो मित्रावरुणा नो गंतं रिशादसा (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā no gaṃtaṃ riśādasā*) (Ā. 5-10). On the twenty-fourth day, at the time of the morning pressing, when the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa recites the śastra mantra, these three Ṛks beginning आ नो मित्रावरुणा (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā*) are to be recited as the tṛca called ṣaḍaha-stotriya[?329]; this is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, आ नो मित्रावरुणा मित्रं वयं हवामहे (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā mitraṃ vayaṃ havāmahe*) (Ā. 7-2). This tṛca is also applied to the āvāpa mantras to be recited for the increase of the stoma; this is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, आ नो मित्रावरुणेति तृचौ (*ā no mitrāvaruṇeti tṛcau*) (Ā. 7-5). The sacrifice called Dākṣāyaṇa is to be performed on two new-moon days. On that occasion, on the day of the second new moon, this Ṛk आ नो मित्रावरुणा (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā*) is to be used on the second day as the purorucā-type anuvākyā mantra[?]

[330] addressed to Mitra and Varuṇa; this is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Sūtra, आ नो मित्रावरुणा यद्बंहिष्ठं नातिविधे सुदानू (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā yadbhaṃhiṣṭhaṃ nātividhe sudānū*)?[331] (Ā. 2-14).

गव्यूतिं (*gavyūtiṃ*)—For this word, गवां मार्गं गोनिवासस्थानं (*gavāṃ mārgaṃ gonivāsasthānaṃ*): the meaning is the path on which cows move, or the dwelling place of cows. In गावो न गव्यूतीः (*gāvo na gavyūtīḥ*) (1-25-16), where

the word *gavyūti* is explained as *goṣṭha*, that is, a cattle-shed. Any cattle-shed filled with grass dear to the cow, any pasture, or any path filled with grass, can all be denoted by the word *gavyūti.*

In passages such as प्र बाहवा सिसृतं जीवसे न आ नो गव्यूतिमुक्षतं धृतेन । (*pra bāhavā sisṛtaṃ jīvase na ā no gavyūtimukṣataṃ dhṛtena* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-62-5) and आ नो मित्रावरुणा हव्यजुष्टिं धृतैर्गव्यूतिमुक्षतमिळाभिः ॥ (*ā no mitrāvaruṇā havyajuṣṭiṃ dhṛtairgavyūtimukṣatamiḷābhiḥ* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-65-4), just as in the present Ṛk, Mitra and Varuṇa are addressed with one and the same prayer: *ghṛtaiḥ gavyūtiṃ ukṣatām*. Sāyaṇa has explained *gavyūti* as the path along which cows go, that is, the land of the cows' passage.

In all these contexts the word *ghṛta* means water. Just as the meaning "water" is given for the word *ghṛta* in passages such as तृतीयो भ्राता धृतपृष्ठः (*tṛtīyo bhrātā dhṛtapṛṣṭhaḥ*) (1-164-1), here too it must be taken as water. In the Nirukta also the word *ghṛta* is read among the names of water (Ni. 2-24). The prayer to Mitra and Varuṇa is: as you cause abundance of grass for our cows, make the region where they graze fertile with water.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒रु॒शंसा॑ नमो॒वृधा॑ म॒ह्ना दक्षं॑स्य राजथः ।
द्राघिं॑ष्ठाभिः शुचिव्रता ॥ १७ ॥

> *uruśaṃsā namovṛdhā mahnā dakṣasya rājathaḥ |*
> *drāghiṣṭhābhiḥ śucivratā ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उरुशंसा । नमःवृधा । मह्ना । दक्षस्य । राजथः ।
> द्राघिष्ठाभिः । शुचिव्रता ॥ १७ ॥

> *uruśaṃsā | namaḥvṛdhā | mahnā | dakṣasya | rājathaḥ |*
> *drāghiṣṭhābhiḥ | śucivratā ‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> शुचिव्रता परिशुद्धकर्माणौ हे मित्रावरुणावुरुशंसा उरुभिर्बहुभिः शंसनीयौ । यद्वा । उरु महच्छंसः शस्त्रं ययोस्तौ । नमोवृधा नमसा हविर्लक्षणे–

> *śucivratā pariśuddhakarmāṇau he mitrāvaruṇāvuruśaṃsā urubhirbahubhiḥ śaṃsanīyau | yadvā | uru mahacchaṃsaḥ śastraṃ yayostau | namovṛdhā namasā havirlakṣaṇe-*

> नान्नेन स्तोत्रेण वा वर्धमानौ द्राघिष्ठाभिरत्यंतं दीर्घस्तुतिलक्षणाभिर्वाग्निर्युक्तौ युवां दक्षस्य । दक्षं धनं बलं वा । तस्य महत्वेन राजथः । ईशाथे ॥
> उरुशंसा । शन्नु स्तुता । कर्मणि घञ् । कृत्स्वरः । द्राघिष्ठाभिः । दीर्घशब्दादिष्ठनि प्रियस्थिरेत्यादिना द्राघीत्यादेशः । नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *nānnena stotreṇa vā vardhamānau drāghiṣṭhābhiratyaṃtaṃ dīrghastutilakṣaṇābhirvāgniryuktau yuvāṃ dakṣasya | dakṣaṃ dhanaṃ balaṃ vā | tasya mahatvena rājathaḥ | īśāthe ‖*
> *uruśaṃsā | śannu stutā | karmaṇi ghañ | kṛtsvaraḥ | drāghiṣṭhābhiḥ | dīrghaśabdādiṣṭhani*
> *priyasthiretyādinā drāghītyādeśaḥ | nittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Mitra and Varuṇa, whose rites are pure (*śucivratā*), you are *uruśaṃsā*: to be praised by many (*uru*, "many"). Or else: you are those who have a great (*uru*) *śaṃsa*, that is, a *śastra* (recitation). You are *namovṛdhā*: growing by *namas*, which is the offering as food, or by the *stotra*. (The block breaks off here; Sāyaṇa's sentence goes on in the next block.)

(Continuing:) you are *namovṛdhā*, growing by food or by praise. You are joined with exceedingly long praises (*drāghiṣṭhābhiḥ*, from *dīrgha*). *Dakṣa* is wealth or strength; by the greatness of that you rule (*rājathaḥ*), that is, you exercise lordship.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Mitra and Varuṇa) शुचिव्रता (*śucivratā*)—those whose rites are pure
- उरुशंसा (*uruśaṃsā*)—praised by many
- नमोवृधा (*namovṛdhā*)—those who grow by the oblation
- द्राघिष्ठाभिः (*drāghiṣṭhābhiḥ*)—you who are endowed with long praise
- दक्षस्य (*dakṣasya*)—of strength and wealth
- मह्ना (*mahnā*)—by the abundance
- राजथः (*rājathaḥ*)—you shine

Gist

O Mitra and Varuṇa, you whose rites are pure, who are praised by many, who grow by the oblation, and who are endowed with long praise, you shine through the abundance of your strength and wealth.

English translation

Performers of pure rites, glorified by many, exalted by adoration, (celebrated) by prolonged praises, you reign by the greatness of (your) strength.

Special Topics

नमोवृधा— नमसा हविर्लक्षणेन अन्नेन स्तोत्रेण वा वर्धमानौ । (*namovṛdhā— namasā havirlakṣaṇena annena stotreṇa vā vardhamānau* |) The word *namas* has two meanings, food and praise. Hence it means either those who grow by food or those who grow by praise.

दक्षस्य महत्वेन राजथः । (*dakṣasya mahatvena rājathaḥ* |) The word *dakṣa* can be given the two meanings wealth or strength. Or else the name *Dakṣa*, the father of Mitra and Varuṇa, may be what is intended. The meaning is that they shine through the greatness of wealth, or the greatness of strength, or the greatness of Dakṣa their father. If *dakṣa* is taken as strength or wealth, then Mitra and Varuṇa themselves become the fathers of *dakṣa*, as in धारयंत देवाः सुदक्षा दक्षपितरा । असुराय प्रमहसा ॥ (*dhārayaṃta devāḥ sudakṣā dakṣapitarā | asurāya pramahasā* ‖) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 7-66-2).[?332]

In passages like this Mitra and Varuṇa are described as protectors of strength. Moreover, it was explained earlier that the combined power of the two words *kratu* and *dakṣa* shows all the powers of Mitra and Varuṇa. For that very reason they are praised with epithets such as *śucivratā* and *uruśaṃsā*.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

गृ॒णा॒ना ज॒मद॑ग्निना॒ योना॑वृ॒तस्य॑ सीदतम् ।
पा॒तं सोम॑मृतावृधा ॥ १८ ॥

> *gṛṇānā jamadagninā yonāvṛtasya sīdatam |*
> *pātaṃ somamṛtāvṛdhā ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गृहाना । जमत् अग्निना । योन् । यतस्य । सीदतं ।
> पातं । सोमं । ऋत्यवृधा ॥ १८ ॥

> *gṛhānā | jamat agninā | yon | yatasya | sīdataṃ |*
> *pātaṃ | somaṃ | ṛtyavṛdhā ‖ 18 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मैत्रावरुणस्य ग्रहस्य याज्या गृणाना जमदग्निनेत्येषा । सूत्रितं च । होता
> यक्षन्मित्रावरुणा गृणाना जमदग्निना । आ. ५–५ । इति ॥ अध्यायोपाकरणे मंडलाद्यंतहोमे
> गृणाना जमदग्निनेत्येषा । आ. गृ. ३–५ ॥
> हे मित्रावरुणौ जमदग्निनैतन्नामकेन महर्षिणा गृणाना स्तूयमानौ
> यद्वा । जमदग्निना प्रज्वलिताग्नि ना विश्वामित्रेण स्तूयमानौ युवामृतस्य यज्ञस्य
> योन् देवयजनाख्ये देशे सीदतं । उपविशतं । ऋतावृधा ऋतस्य कर्मफलस्य

> वर्धयितारौ युवां सोमं पातं । पिबतं ॥ गृणाना । गृ शब्दे । व्यत्ययेन
> कर्मणि शानच् । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । सीदतं । सदेर्लोटि प्राघ्रेत्यादिना सीदादेशः । पातं । पा
> पाने । बहुलं छंदसीति शपो लुक् ॥

> *maitrāvaruṇasya grahasya yājyā gṛṇānā jamadagninetyeṣā | sūtritaṃ ca | hotā*
> *yakṣanmitrāvaruṇā gṛṇānā jamadagninā | ā. 5-5 | iti ‖*
> *adhyāyopākaraṇe maṃḍalādyaṃtahome gṛṇānā jamadagninetyeṣā | ā. gṛ. 3-5 ‖*
> *he mitrāvaruṇau jamadagninaitannāmakena maharṣiṇā gṛṇānā stūyamānau*
> *yadvā | jamadagninā prajvalitāgni nā viśvāmitreṇa stūyamānau yuvāmṛtasya yajñasya*
> *yon devayajanākhyè deśe sīdataṃ | upaviśataṃ | ṛtāvṛdhā ṛtasya karmaphalasya*
> *vardhayitārau yuvāṃ somaṃ pātaṃ | pibataṃ ‖ gṛṇānā | gṛ śabde | vyatyayena*
> *karmaṇi śānac | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | sīdataṃ | saderloṭi prāghretyādinā sīdādeśaḥ | pātaṃ | pā pāne | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapo luk ‖*

Summary

This Ṛk, गृणाना जमदग्निना (*gṛṇānā jamadagninā*), is the yājyā of the Maitrāvaruṇa graha. It is prescribed in the sūtra: होता यक्षन्मित्रावरुणा गृणाना जमदग्निना (*hotā yakṣanmitrāvaruṇā gṛṇānā jamadagninā*) (Ā. 5-5). At the *adhyāyopākaraṇa*, in the homa at the end of a maṇḍala, this Ṛk is also used (Ā. Gṛ. 3-5).[?333]

O Mitra and Varuṇa, you who are praised (*gṛṇānā*) by the great seer named Jamadagni. Or else: *jamadagni* is "he by whom fire is kindled", that is, Viśvāmitra, by whom you are praised. Sit (*sīdatam*), take your seat, in the place of the *yajña* (*ṛta*), the region called the place of divine worship (*devayajana*). You who augment (*ṛtāvṛdhā*) the *ṛta*, that is, the fruit of the rite, drink (*pātam*) the Soma.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Mitra and Varuṇa) जमदग्निना (*jamadagninā*)—by the seer Jamadagni

- गृणाना (*gṛṇānā*)—you who are praised
- यतस्य (*yatasya*)—of the sacrifice
- योन् (*yon*)—in the place of the altar
- सीदतं (*sīdataṃ*)—sit down
- यतावृधा (*yatāvṛdhā*)—you who augment the sacrifice
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- पातं (*pātaṃ*)—drink

Gist

O Mitra and Varuṇa, praised by Jamadagni, sit on this sacrificial altar, and as augmenters of the sacrifice drink the Soma.

English translation

Glorified by Jamadagni, sit down in the place of sacrifice (the altar); drink, augmenters (of the reward) of sacrifice, the Soma libation.

Special Topics

That this Ṛk गृणाना जमदग्निना (*gṛṇānā jamadagninā*) is to be recited as the yājyā mantra of the Maitrāvaruṇa graha is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, होता यक्षन्मित्रावरुणा गृणाना जमदग्निना (*hotā yakṣanmitrāvaruṇā gṛṇānā jamadagninā*) (Ā. 5-5). And that, at the *adhyāyopākaraṇa*, the Ṛk गृणाना जमदग्निना (*gṛṇānā jamadagninā*) is to be recited as a homa mantra at the end of the maṇḍala is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Gṛhya Sūtra गृणाना जमदग्निना (*gṛṇānā jamadagninā*) (Ā. Gṛ. 3-5-6).

एतन्नामकेन महर्षिणा स्तूयमानौ । यद्वा । जमदग्निना प्रज्वलिताग्निना विश्वामित्रेण स्तूयमानौ । (*etannāmakena maharṣiṇā stūyamānau* | *yadvā* | *jamadagninā prajvalitāgninā viśvāmitreṇa stūyamānau* |) One meaning is: Mitra and Varuṇa praised by the great seer named Jamadagni. Or, if the word *jamadagni* is taken as "kindled fire", it means Viśvāmitra, who kindled the fire for the sacrifice; the other meaning is then Mitra and Varuṇa praised by such a Viśvāmitra. Thus Sāyaṇa has given two kinds of explanation. To say that the seer is named Jamadagni is the proper course.

The great seer Jamadagni was an intimate friend of Viśvāmitra. In the Ṛgveda, these hymns are famed as composed by Jamadagni: 3-62-16 to 18; 8-101; 9-62; 9-65; 9-67-16 to 18; 10-110; 10-137-6; 10-167. He is the son of Bhṛgu, and so is known as Jamadagni Bhārgava. In many places he states his own praise openly with the words गृणानो जमदग्निना (*gṛṇāno jamadagninā*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 9-62-24; 9-65-25, etc.).

In प्रसूतो भक्षमकरं चरावपि स्तोमं चेमं प्रथमः सूरिरुन्मृजे । सुते सातेन यद्यागमं नां प्रति विश्वामित्रजमदग्नी दमे ॥ (*prasūto bhakṣamakaraṃ carāvapi stomaṃ cemaṃ prathamaḥ sūrirunmṛje | sute sātena yadyāgamaṃ nāṃ prati viśvāmitrajamadagnī dame ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-167-4), Indra addresses Viśvāmitra and Jamadagni together and shows his favour. This companionship is described in many places. That the two were able to contend with Vasiṣṭha is also well known in the Saṃhitās and other works.

विश्वामित्रजमदग्नी वसिष्ठेनास्पर्धेतागं् स एतज्जव दग्निर्विहव्यमपश्यत्तेन वै स वसिष्ठस्येंद्रियं वीर्यमवृंक्त ॥ (*viśvāmitrajamadagnī vasiṣṭhenāspardhetāgṃ sa etajjava dagnirvihavyamapaśyattena vai sa vasiṣṭhasyeṃdriyaṃ vīryamavṛṃkta ‖*) (Tai. Saṃ. 3-1-7-3). While Viśvāmitra and Jamadagni were both contending with Vasiṣṭha, Jamadagni received the vision of the Vihavya hymn, which begins with the mantra ममाग्ने वर्चो विहवेष्टस्तु वयं तैंधानास्तन्वं पुषेम (*mamāgne varco vihaveṣṭastu vayaṃ taiṃdhānāstanvaṃ puṣema*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-128). With its help he took all of Vasiṣṭha's power for himself; this is told in story form in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā. In the Bṛhaddevatā another historical occasion of the same kind is stated thus:

सुदासश्च महायज्ञे शक्तिना गाथिसूनवे । निगृहीतं बलाच्चेतः सोऽवसीदद्विचेतनः । तस्मै ब्राह्मीं तु सौरीं वा नाम्ना वाचं ससर्परीं । सूर्यक्षयादिहाहृत्य वदुस्ते जमदग यः । कुशिकानां ततः सा नागमुतिं तामपाहनत् ॥ (*sudāsaśca mahāyajñe śaktinā gāthisūnave | nigṛhītaṃ balāccetaḥ so 'vasīdadvicetanaḥ | tasmai brāhmīṃ tu saurīṃ vā nāmnā vācaṃ sasarparīṃ | sūryakṣayādihāhṛtya vaduste jamadaga yaḥ | kuśikānāṃ tataḥ sā nāgamutiṃ tāmapāhanat ‖*) (Bṛ. De. 4-112 to 114).

At the great sacrifice of Sudās, the son of Gādhi (Viśvāmitra), struck by Śakti, the son of Vasiṣṭha, fainted and fell to the ground bereft of consciousness. Then Jamadagni provided the help of the speech named Sasarparī, the daughter of the Sun (or of Brahmā). That goddess of speech removed the faint of the son of Kuśika and made consciousness return to him. This occasion is indicated in the Ṛgveda in Ṛks such as

ससर्परीरमतिं बाधमाना बृहन्दि माय जमदग्नि दत्ता । आ सूरस्य दुहिता ततान श्रवो देवेष्वमृतमजुर्यं ॥ ((*sasarparīramatiṃ bādhamānā bṛhandi māya jamadagni dattā | ā sūrasya duhitā tatāna śravo deveṣvamṛtamajuryaṃ* ‖ *()* (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3 53-5).[?334]

Its special meaning was explained earlier.

Even when relating such stories, the word *jamadagni* is sometimes explained also from the spiritual point of view. In such contexts it is said that Jamadagni was a son of Prajāpati and that, looking at the truth of the world with his divine vision, he made a knowledge-like light for the world. For example:

प्रजापतिर्विराजमपश्यत्तया भूतं च भव्यं चासृजत तामृषिभ्यस्तिरोदधात्तां जमदग्निस्तपदापश्यत्तया वै स पृश्नीन्मानसृजत । (*prajāpatirvirājamapaśyattayā bhūtaṃ ca bhavyaṃ cāsṛjata tāmṛṣibhyastirodadhāttāṃ jamadagnistapadāpaśyattayā vai sa pṛśnīnmānasṛjata |*) (Tai. Saṃ. 3-3-5-2).

Prajāpati received the vision of the Virāj; with its help he created what has been and what is to be. But he made both of them lie outside the range of the seers' perception. Then Jamadagni, by the greatness of his austerity, obtained the vision of them and created from them many kinds of objects of desire; so his power of divine vision is described. In the same way the Upaniṣads tell us that Jamadagni is a part that mirrors the spiritual truth:

इमावेव गोतमभारद्वाजौ, अयमेव गोतमः, अयं भारद्वाजः । इमावेव विश्वामित्रजमदग्नी, अयमेव विश्वामित्रः, अयं जमदग्निः । (*imāveva gotamabhāradvājau, ayameva gotamaḥ, ayaṃ bhāradvājaḥ | imāveva viśvāmitrajamadagnī, ayameva viśvāmitraḥ, ayaṃ jamadagniḥ |*) (Bṛ. U. 2-2-4).

This is stated in the Bṛhadāraṇyaka when the truth of the body is explained. Of these, Gotama and Bharadvāja expound the principle of the ear; Viśvāmitra and Jamadagni expound the principle of the eye. Viśvāmitra is said to be the right eye and Jamadagni the left eye. But here the meaning is not merely the physical eye; it is to be understood as the eye of knowledge. How? In the sentence प्रजापतिर्वै जमदग्निः, सोऽश्वमेधः । (*prajāpatirvai jamadagniḥ, so 'śvamedhaḥ |*) (Śa. Brā. 13-2-2-14), Jamadagni is designated as Prajāpati himself, and the special quality of such a Jamadagni is this:

जमदग्नि र्यषिरिति । चक्षुर्वै जमदग्नि र्यषिर्यदेनेन जगत्पश्यत्यथो मनुते तस्माच्चक्षुर्जमदग्नि र्यषिः प्रजापतिगृहीतया त्वयेति प्रजापतिसृष्टया त्वयेत्येतच्चक्षुर्गृह्णामि ॥ (*jamadagni ryaṣiriti | cakṣurvai jamadagni ryaṣiryadenena jagatpaśyatyatho manute tasmāccakṣurjamadagni ryaṣiḥ prajāpatigṛhītayā tvayeti prajāpatisṛṣṭayā tvayetyetaccakṣurgṛhṇāmi ||*) (Śa. Brā. 8-1-2-3).

The great seer Jamadagni himself is the eye. He is the divine eye by whose help the whole world gains the power of sight and the power of consciousness. "O Jamadagni, created by Prajāpati, by your divine favour may the power of sight come to all my progeny": thus Jamadagni is prayed to for the divine knowledge by which the spiritual truth is known. The Taittirīya Āraṇyaka states the same import:

यदक्षरं भूतकृतं । विश्वेदेवा उपासते । महर्षिमस्य गोप्तारं । जमदग्निमकुर्वत । जमदग्निराप्यायते । छंदोभिश्च तुरुत्तरैः । राजस्थोमस्य तृप्ता सः ॥ (*yadakṣaraṃ bhūtakṛtaṃ | viśvedevā upāsate | maharṣimasya goptāraṃ | jamadagnimakurvata | jamadagnirāpyāyate | chaṃdobhiśca turuttaraiḥ | rājasthomasya tṛptā saḥ ||*) (Trai. Ā. 1-9-7).[?335]

By these sentences it is shown that Jamadagni is of the nature of the imperishable (*akṣara*) Supreme Self.

वेदार्थस्य प्रकाशेन तमो हार्दं निवारयन् । पुमर्थांश्च तुरो देयाद्विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरः । (*vedārthasya prakāśena tamo hārdaṃ nivārayan | pumarthāṃśca turo deyādvidyātīrthamaheśvaraḥ |*)

इति श्रीमद्राजाधिराजपरमेश्वरवैदिकमार्गप्रवर्तकश्रीवीरबुक्कभूपालसाम्राज्यधुरंधरेण सायणाचार्येण विरचिते माधवीये वेदार्थप्रकाशे ऋक्संहिताभाष्ये तृतीयाष्टके तृतीये मंडले पंचमोऽनुवाकः (*iti śrīmadrājādhirājaparameśvaravaidikamārgapravartakaśrīvīrabukkabhūpālasāmrājyadhuraṃdhareṇa sāyaṇācāryeṇa viracite mādhavīye vedārthaprakāśe ṛksaṃhitābhāṣye tṛtīyāṣṭake tṛtīye maṃḍale paṃcamo 'nuvākaḥ*)

The third Maṇḍala is concluded.

ओं तत्रत् (*oṃ tatrat*)

Here the third Maṇḍala of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā (in the third Aṣṭaka), accompanied by the Bhāṣya of Śrī Sāyaṇa and by a Kannada translation, is concluded.

यदक्षरपदभ्रष्टं मात्राहीनं तु यद्भवेत् । तत्सर्वं क्षम्यतां देव वागीश्वर नमोऽस्तु ते ॥ (*yadakṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ tu yadbhavet | tatsarvaṃ kṣamyatāṃ deva vāgīśvara namo 'stu te ‖*)

May there be good. Auspiciousness.

Śrī 4. Now the fourth Maṇḍala.

The fourth Maṇḍala.

Introduction

A brief account of the seer Vāmadeva.

This sūkta was seen by the seer Vāmadeva. We shall describe the seer Vāmadeva briefly at the beginning of this Maṇḍala. This Vāmadeva is the son of the seer Gotama. Of the sūktas of this fourth Maṇḍala, sūktas 1–7 (206 Ṛks in all); in the 18th sūkta, verses 2–3½ and 8–13 (8½ Ṛks in all); sūktas 19–41 (299 Ṛks in all); and 45–58 (107 Ṛks in all)—all these together make a total of 560½ Ṛks, and he is the seer of them.

The Śruti passages praise Vāmadeva in many ways as a great seer who had attained knowledge of Brahman. The Bṛhadāraṇyaka and the other Upaniṣads, the author of the Brahma-sūtras and others, when they examine the nature of the knowledge of Brahman and its means, praise the example of Vāmadeva himself. Such a divine knower is renowned as the seer of the fourth Maṇḍala of the Ṛk Saṃhitā. It is also stated that he is a part of Brahman who shines in the outer space in the form of the Sun and in the heart-space of man in the form of the vital breath. Although all the seers of the Ṛk Saṃhitā are described as particular manifestations of Brahman, the praise concerning Vāmadeva is extraordinary. That this great seer is a manifest person of Brahman in the form of the vital breath is described in the Aitareya Āraṇyaka as follows.

एष इमं लोकमभ्यार्चत्पुरुषरूपेण य एष तपति (*eṣa imaṃ lokamabhyārcatpuruṣarūpeṇa ya eṣa tapati*)

(I. Ā. 9-20)[?336]

The Supreme Brahman who shines in the form of the Sun pervaded the earth in the form of a person. Then all the gods too wished, "May he be dear to us all." Because he whom all the gods wished to be dear to them became known as Vāmadeva, even though he was born from the form of a person, he was not covered by the ignorance natural to a person.

By the three mantras beginning अहं मनुरभवं (*ahaṃ manurabhavaṃ*), Vāmadeva, dwelling in the womb, having attained knowledge of the truth, declared his experience of being everything, showing it in the forms of Manu and the rest. By three mantras of the meaning "I became Manu, the Prajāpati" and so on, Vāmadeva describes how, while still in the womb, he attained omniscience and the experience of himself in the forms of Manu and others.

गर्भे नु सन्नन्वेषामवेदमहं देवानां जनिमानि विश्वा । शतं मा पुर आयसीररक्षन्नध श्येनो जवसा निरदीयं ॥ (*garbhe nu sannanveṣāmavedamahaṃ devānāṃ janimāni viśvā | śataṃ mā pura āyasīrarakṣannadha śyeno javasā niradīyaṃ ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-27-1)

"While still in the womb I knew the manner of origin of all the gods. Hundreds of iron bars bound me. But freed from them, I flew out swiftly like a falcon (śyena)." Quoting this Saṃhitā passage, which he himself spoke, in the Aitareya Āraṇyaka,

गर्भ एवैतच्छयानो वामदेव एवमुवाच । स एवं विद्वानस्माच्छरीरभेदादूर्ध्व उत्क्रम्यामुष्मिन्वर्गे लोके सर्वान्कामानाप्त्वामृतः समभवत्समभवत् ॥ (*garbha evaitacchayāno vāmadeva evamuvāca | sa evaṃ vidvānasmāccharīrabhedādūrdhva utkramyāmuṣminvarge loke sarvānkāmānāptvāmṛtaḥ samabhavatsamabhavat ‖*)

(I. Ā. 9-5-1)

it is praised thus: Vāmadeva recited this sentence while still in the womb; having known this truth, he broke through the body in the womb, became free, enjoyed all the delights of heaven and became immortal. In अध शैनो जवसा निरदीयं (*adha śaino javasā niradīyaṃ*), for शैनः (*śainaḥ*) Sāyaṇa has stated शैनवत् (*śainavat*), "like the falcon", the word being a mark of comparison. Others say that, since there is here no word that indicates comparison, identity of Vāmadeva with the falcon is stated. If identity is stated in this way, one must examine what the word शैन (*śaina*) means. Moreover, that such a divine knower is said to have suffered the misery of poverty and, as a result, to have done a blameworthy deed is also a cause of doubt.

अवर्त्या शुन आंत्राणि पेचे न देवेषु विविदे मर्डितारं । अपश्यं जायाममहीयमानामधा मे श्येनो मध्वा जभार ॥ (*avartyā śuna āṃtrāṇi pece na deveṣu vivide marḍitāraṃ | apaśyaṃ jāyāmamahīyamānāmadhā me śyeno madhvā jabhāra ‖*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-18-13)

"Without means of livelihood I cooked the entrails of a dog. No god who would make me happy appeared to me. I saw my wife too in a wretched state. Then Indra, swift like a falcon, brought me honey." So runs the description. In such circumstances it is a labour to know what the real meaning is. Speaking of himself,

महो रुजामि बंधुता वचोभिस्तन्ना पितुर्गोतमादन्वियाय । (*maho rujāmi baṃdhutā vacobhistannā piturgotamādanviyāya |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-4-11)

"O Agni, praising you with the speech of praise received from my father Gotama, I shall be able, by your grace, to destroy all enemies." In saying this he has declared himself the son of Gotama. This seer composed most excellent sūktas addressed to deities such as Agni and Indra. Stating this very thing, the Bṛhaddevatā says:

सोग्निं तु पंचदशभिरिंद्रं षोडशभिः परैः । यषिस्वामिति तुष्टाव सूक्तैरेति तु गौतमः ॥ (*sogniṃ tu paṃcadaśabhiriṃdraṃ ṣoḍaśabhiḥ paraiḥ | yaṣisvāmiti tuṣṭāva sūktaireti tu gautamaḥ ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 4-12)

Vāmadeva, son of Gotama, praised Agni with the fifteen sūktas beginning with the mantra त्वां ह्यग्ने सदमित् (*tvāṃ hyagne sadamit*), and Indra with the sixteen sūktas beginning with the mantra आ सत्यो यातु (*ā satyo yātu*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-16-32). Thus the sūktas are divided according to the order of the deities. And in the mantras beginning स भ्रातरं (*sa bhrātaraṃ*) the circumstances that give room for doubt are also described. That a fight took place between Vāmadeva and Indra, and that although Indra was defeated Vāmadeva praised Indra, is also a strange circumstance from the worldly point of view. This story is described as follows.

अंजसा न जनिष्येऽहं ब्रुवाणं गर्भमेव तु । अन्वशाददितिः पुत्रं इंद्रमात्महितैषिणी । स जातमात्रो युद्धाय ऋषिमेवाजुहाव तु ॥ (*aṃjasā na janiṣye 'haṃ bruvāṇaṃ garbhameva tu | anvaśādaditiḥ putraṃ iṃdramātmahitaiṣiṇī | sa jātamātro yuddhāya ṛṣimevājuhāva tu ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 4-130, 131)

As soon as the son in the womb said, "I shall not be born in the natural way," Aditi, intent on her own protection, rebuked her son Indra. That same Indra, as soon as he was born, confronted the seer Vāmadeva as if to fight him.

योधयन्नामदेवस्तं कृत्वात्मनि बलं तथा । दिनानि दश रात्रीश्च विजिग्ये चैनमोजसा ॥ (*yodhayannāmadevastaṃ kṛtvātmani balaṃ tathā | dināni daśa rātrīśca vijigye cainamojasā ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 4-132)

Fighting with Indra, who had resolved to do him harm, he made him struggle for ten days, night and day. In the end, by his superior strength, he defeated him completely.

स तं क इममित्य स्यां विक्रीणन्नृषिसंसदि । स्वयं तेनाभितुष्टाव नकिरिंद्रेति गौतमः ॥ (*sa taṃ ka imamitya syāṃ vikrīṇannṛṣisaṃsadi | svayaṃ tenābhituṣṭāva nakiriṃdreti gautamaḥ ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 4-133)

Then Vāmadeva, by the Ṛk क इमं (*ka imaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-24-10), presenting Indra who had come under his control, became in the assembly of seers a seller of Indra, and even at the time of the sale he fixes the terms. (Sāyaṇācārya has described the circumstances of this same occasion, in the form of verses composed by earlier teachers, in the introduction to mantra 4-24-10.) And by the mantras beginning न किरिंद्र त्वदुत्तरः (*na kiriṃdra tvaduttaraḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-30-1) he praised Indra.

किमादुतासीति चास्यां मन्युमर्धे पराणुदत् । अथास्य रूपवीर्याणि धैर्यकार्याणि तान्वृषिः ॥ विविधानि च कर्माणि शशंसादितये तथा । अह मित्यात्मसंस्तावस्त्रचे स्तुतिरिवास्य हि ॥ प्र सु ष विभो नवभिर्यग्निः श्येनस्य संस्तवः । पराभिस्तृति पंचर्चे सोमेनेंद्रः स्तुतः सह ॥ (*kimādutāsīti cāsyāṃ manyumardhe parāṇudat | athāsya rūpavīryāṇi dhairyakāryāṇi tānvṛṣiḥ ‖ vividhāni ca karmāṇi śaśaṃsāditaye tathā | aha mityātmasaṃstāvastrace stutirivāsya hi ‖ pra su ṣa vibho navabhiryagniḥ śyenasya saṃstavaḥ | parābhistṛti paṃcarce somenemḍraḥ stutaḥ saha ‖*)

(Bṛ. De. 4-134 to 6; printed Bṛ. Ḍe.)

By the mantra किमादुतासि (*kimādutāsi*) (4-20-7) he praised Indra and appeased his anger. Then he praised and extolled Indra's heroic deeds, his firmness and his daring. By the mantras beginning अहं मनुः (*ahaṃ manuḥ*) (4-26-1) he also praised his own greatness and declared it before Aditi. In these praises he seems to have declared identity between himself and Indra. In the mantras beginning प्र सु ष विभ्यः (*pra su ṣa vibhyaḥ*) (4-26-4-7) there is praise of the falcon (Śyena). After that there is again praise of Indra together with Soma. Thus Vāmadeva's skill of composition is praised. In the same way his skill of composition is praised in other places also.

संपातौ भवतो निष्केवल्यमरुत्वतीययोर्निविद्वाने वामदेवो वा इमाल्लोकानपश्यत्तान्संपातैः समपतद्यत्संपातैः समपतत्तत्संपातानां संपा- तत्वं तद्यत्संपातौ प्रथमेऽहनि शंसति स्वर्गस्य लोकस्य समष्टेऽ संपत्तेऽ संगत्यै ॥ (*saṃpātau bhavato niṣkevalyamarutvatīyayornividvāne vāmadevo vā imāllokānapaśyattānsaṃpātaiḥ samapatadyatsaṃpātaiḥ samapatattatsaṃpātānāṃ saṃpā- tatvaṃ tadyatsaṃpātau prathame 'hani śaṃsati svargasya lokasya samaṣṭe ' saṃpatte ' saṃgatyai ‖*)

(I. Brā. 4-30)[?337]

In the Niṣkevalya-śastra and also in the Marutvatīya-śastra, the mantras to be offered are in the form of saṃpātas (they follow upon one another). आ यात्विंद्रोऽवस (*ā yātviṃdro 'vasa*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-21-1) is the sūkta, in the form of a nivid-dhāna, to be offered in the Marutvatīya-śastra. The one that begins with the mantra आ न इंद्रो दूरात् (*ā na iṃdro dūrāt*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-20-1) is the sūkta

to be offered in the Niṣkevalya-śastra in the form of a nivid-dhāna. Both of these bear the name saṃpāta. Formerly the seer Vāmadeva, having surveyed all the worlds beginning with Bhūr and wishing to visit them all, was thinking about the means of reaching them, and finally composed these saṃpāta-sūktas; by their power he flew to all of them in the manner of a bird's flight and reached them. Since it is established that, by their greatness, all who recite them will likewise go and reach the worlds beginning with Bhūr, the name saṃpāta became famous for them. The man who, on the first day of the Niṣkevalya and Marutvatīya śastras, recites these saṃpāta-sūktas with faith obtains all prosperity and attains union with heaven. Thus the power of Vāmadeva's composition is praised. A circumstance in which the seer Viśvāmitra could not bear the greatness of the power of these mantras is also stated as follows:

तान्ना एतान्संपातान्विश्वामित्रः प्रथममपश्यत्तान्विश्वामित्रेण दृष्टान्वामदेपोऽसृजतैवा त्वामिंद्र वज्रिन्नत्र .... तत्संपातानां संपातत्वं ॥ (*tānnā etānsaṃpātānviśvāmitraḥ prathamamapaśyattānviśvāmitreṇa dṛṣṭānvāmadepo 'sṛjataivā tvāmiṃdra vajrinnatra .... tatsaṃpātānāṃ saṃpātatvaṃ ‖*)

(Ai. Brā. 6-18)

The great seer Viśvāmitra, by the grace of God, saw the saṃpāta-sūktas at the very time of creation, and also knew in his mind the power of these mantras among the Vedas. Vāmadeva studied these sūktas seen by Viśvāmitra and published them in the world in his own name. एवा त्वामिंद्र वज्रिन् (*evā tvāmiṃdra vajrin*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-19-1), यन्न इंद्रो जुजुषे (*yanna iṃdro jujuṣe*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-22-1), कथा महामवृधत्कस्य होतुः (*kathā mahāmavṛdhatkasya hotuḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-23-1) are those seen by Viśvāmitra and created by Vāmadeva. Knowing this, Viśvāmitra, wishing to make his own name famous, composed in return for these the saṃpāta-mantras beginning सद्यो ह जातो वृषभः (*sadyo ha jāto vṛṣabhaḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-48-1); this circumstance too is described. Circumstances of this kind also praise Vāmadeva's skill of composition.

The Upaniṣads and other texts praise his divine knowledge, saying that Vāmadeva was a great divine knower, and that everyone who wishes to be freed from the sorrow of saṃsāra and to attain the eternal union with Brahman must know what the nature of the great seer Vāmadeva's knowledge was. In the Aitareya Upaniṣad:

तदुक्तमृषिणा—गर्भे नु सन्नन्वेषां .... इति । गर्भ ए वैतच्छयानो वामदेव एवमुवाच ॥
(*taduktamṛṣiṇā—garbhe nu sannanveṣāṃ .... iti | garbha e vaitacchayāno vāmadeva evamuvāca ‖*)

(I. U. 9.5)[?338]

The text continues the account of Vāmadeva's divine knowledge. In all three states that bind a man, beginning with birth, a man falls into the ocean of saṃsāra and wanders in it. The Vāmadeva Ṛṣi has declared that such a man is freed from the bondage of saṃsāra the moment he knows the nature of the Self. While still in his mother's womb, he says, "I have come to know all the births of the deities, of Vāk, Agni and the rest. The limbs of the body were bonds to me, like iron bars. As a hawk breaks the net and flies off with the speed of the wind, so I too, the moment I was without bonds, flew out with the strength gained from knowledge of the Self." Vāmadeva spoke this utterance while still in the womb.

स एवं विद्वानस्माच्छरीरभेदादूर्ध्व उत्क्रम्यामुष्मिन् स्वर्गे लोके सर्वान् कामानाप्त्वामृतः समभवत्समभवत् ॥ (*sa evaṃ vidvānasmāccharīrabhedādūrdhva utkramyāmuṣmin svarge loke sarvān kāmānāptvāmṛtaḥ samabhavatsamabhavat* ‖) (I. U. 2-6)[?339]

The moment Vāmadeva had knowledge of the Self, the body was split. That is, the chain of bodies, imagined through ignorance, hard like things of iron and an extremely firm bondage, joined to hundreds of series of misfortunes such as birth and death, all the fetters in the form of nescience were destroyed as soon as he tasted the nectar of knowledge of the Supreme Self. Then, having the nature of the Supreme Self and having attained the state of being the Self of all, he became immortal.

ब्रह्मविद्यासाधनकृतसर्वात्मभावफलावाप्तिं नामदेवाद्याचार्यपरंपरया श्रुत्या अवद्योत्यमानां ब्रह्मवित्परिषदि अत्यंतप्रसिद्धां उपलभमाना मुमुक्षवः अधुनातनाः ब्रह्मजिज्ञासवः अनित्यात् साध्यसाधनलक्षणात् संसारात् आजीवभावाद्व्याविवृत्सवो विचारयंतोऽन्योन्यं पृच्छंति ।.... यदेतद्हृदयं मनश्चैतत् ॥ (*brahmavidyāsādhanakṛtasarvātmabhāvaphalāvāptiṃ nāmadevādyācāryaparaṃparayā śrutyā avadyotyamānāṃ brahmavitpariṣadi atyaṃtaprasiddhāṃ upalabhamānā mumukṣavaḥ adhunātanāḥ brahmajijñāsavaḥ anityāt sādhyasādhanalakṣaṇāt saṃsārāt ājīvabhāvādvyāvivṛtsavo vicārayaṃto 'nyonyaṃ pṛcchaṃti* |.... *yadetadhṛdayaṃ manaścaitat* ‖) (Ai. U. Śa. Bhā. 3-1)[?340]

That the fruit called the state of being the Self of all is obtained by the means that is the knowledge of Brahman has been made clear by the tradition of teachers beginning with Vāmadeva and by the Śruti passages composed by them. Those who wish to be freed from impermanent saṃsāra, and those who desire to know Brahman, are questioning one another on this matter: "Who is the Self? How is it to be worshipped?" and so on. The divine knowledge of Vāmadeva is praised because even for such questions the utterances of seers like Vāmadeva are the authority. The meaning is that when the divine knowledge "I am Brahman" arises, as Vāmadeva knew it, people are freed from saṃsāra just as Vāmadeva was.

ब्रह्म वा इदमग्र आसीत्तदात्मानमेवावेत् । अहं ब्रह्मास्मीति । तस्मात्तत्सर्वमभवत्तद्यो यो देवानां प्रत्यबुध्यत स एव तदभवत्तथर्षिणां तथा मनुष्याणां तद्धैतत्पश्यन्नृषिर्वामदेवः प्रतिपेदेऽहं मनुरभवं सूर्यश्चेति । तदिदमप्येतर्हि य एवं वेदाहं ब्रह्मास्मीति स इदं सर्वं भवति॥ (*brahma vā idamagra āsīttadātmānamevāvet | ahaṃ brahmāsmīti | tasmāttatsarvamabhavattadyo yo devānāṃ pratyabudhyata sa eva tadabhavattatharṣiṇāṃ tathā manuṣyāṇāṃ tadbhaitatpaśyannṛṣirvāmadevaḥ pratipede 'haṃ manurabhavaṃ sūryaśceti | tadidamapyetarhi ya evaṃ vedāhaṃ brahmāsmīti sa idaṃ sarvaṃ bhavati‖*) (Bṛ. U. 1-4-10)

At first, before creation, only Brahman existed. It gained the knowledge of the Self, "I am Brahman." Therefore it attained the state of being the Self of all and became all-pervading. Among the deities too, whoever gained this knowledge attained this same state. The seers and men too gained perfection by this means in the form of knowledge. Vāmadeva also, having gained this same knowledge of Brahman, declared his state of being the Self of all: "I was Manu, I was Sūrya." Thus the nature of the knowledge of Brahman is taught: all who gain the knowledge "I am Brahman" attain perfection in the form of being the Self of all.

Vāmadeva's utterance "I was Manu" is quoted in the Vedānta Sūtra, and there it has given occasion for a statement of meaning in the inquiry into the nature of the knowledge of Brahman.

शास्त्रदृष्टि तपदेशो नामदेववत् (*śāstradṛṣṭi tapadeśo nāmadevavat*) (Bra. Sū. 1-1-31)

In the passage of the Chāndogya Upaniṣad अनेन जीवेनात्मनानुप्रविश्य नामरूपे व्याकरवाणीति (*anena jīvenātmanānupraviśya nāmarūpe vyākaravāṇīti*) (Chā. U. 6-3-2), "entering all places in the form of the living self, he becomes modified by the respective names and forms." The relation of identity between Brahman and the deity that holds there is understood in the same way from Vāmadeva's utterances such as "I was Manu." But here it has also given room to the debate between dualism and non-dualism, whether the individual nature of the living self is one with the principle of Brahman or distinct from it. This question is not now in hand. The main point is that the divine knowledge of Vāmadeva is praised in all the Śruti passages, and all the Śrutis, the Brāhmaṇas and the rest, somewhere or other quote and discuss the utterance of this great seer.

Maṇḍala 4

Sūkta 1 (Maṇḍala 4)

The first sūkta.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> वामदेव्ये चतुर्थे मंडले पंचानुवाकाः । तत्र प्रथमेऽनुवाके दश
> सूक्तानि । तेषु त्वां ह्यग्ने सदमिदिति विंशत्यृचं प्रथमं सूक्तं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । त्वां ह्यग्ने
> विंशतिरष्ट्यतिजगतीधृतय आद्या उपाद्याश्चतस्रो
> वारुण्यश्च वेति । मंडलद्रष्टा वामदेवऋषिः । प्रथमा चतुःषष्ट्यक्षराष्टिर्द्वितीया
> द्विपंचाशदक्षरातिजगती तृतीया द्विसप्तत्यक्षरा धृतिश्चतुर्थाद्या अनादेशपरिभाषया
> सप्तदश त्रिष्टुभः । कृत्सस्य सूक्तस्य मंडलादिष्टाग्नेयमिति परिभाषयाग्निर्देवता
> द्वितीयाद्याश्चतस्रो वरुणदेवत्या वा ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥ आद्याध्यायो
> पाकरणे मंडलादिहोमे विनियुक्ता ॥
> अनुवादवु—वामदेवऋषिदृष्टवाद ई नाल्कनॆय मंडलदल्लि ऐदु अनुवाकगळिरुववु
> अवुगळल्लि मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हत्तु सूक्तगळिरुववु. आ हत्तु सूक्तगळल्लि त्वां ह्यग्ने
> सदमित् ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆयदु. इदरल्लि इप्पत्तु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—
> त्वां ह्यग्ने विंशतिरष्टृतिजगतीधृतय आद्या उपाद्याश्चतस्रो वारुण्यश्च ना ऎंदु
> हेळिरुवुदु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ मंडलद्रष्टृवाद वामदेवने ऋषियु ; ई सूक्तदल्लि अरवत्तुनाल्कु
> अक्षरगळुळ्ळ मॊदलनॆय ऋक्कु अष्टि ऎंब छंदस्सिनदु ; ऐवत्तॆरडु अक्षरगळुळ्ळ ऎरडनॆय ऋक्कु
> अतिजगतीछंदस्कवु ; ऎप्पत्तॆरडु अक्षरगळुळ्ळ मूरनॆय ऋक्कु धृति ऎंब छंदस्सिनदु ;
> नाल्कनॆय
> ऋक्किनिंद सूक्तद कॊनॆयवरॆगिन हदिनेळु ऋक्कुगळू त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्कवु. मंडलादिष्टाग्नेयं—मंडलद
> प्रारंभद सूक्तवु अग्नि देवताकवागिरुवुदु ऎंब परिभाषॆगनुसारवागि
> ई मॊदलनॆय पूर्ता सूक्तक्कॆ अग्नियु देवतॆयु ; ऎरडनॆय ऋक्किनिंद नाल्कु ऋक्कुगळिगॆ
> (२–५ ऋक्कुगळिगॆ) अग्नि अथवा वरुणनु देवतॆयु. सूक्तविनियोगवु लैंगिकवु. ई सूक्तद
> मॊदलनॆय ऋक्कन्नु अध्यायोत्सर्जन उपाकर्महोमगळल्लि मंडलहोमक्कागि विनियोगि
> सुव रूढि इरुवुदु.

> *vāmadevye caturthe maṃḍale paṃcānuvākāḥ | tatra prathame 'nuvāke daśa*
> *sūktāni | teṣu tvāṃ hyagne sadamiditi viṃśatyṛcaṃ prathamaṃ sūktaṃ | atreyamanukramaṇikā | tvāṃ hyagne viṃśatiraṣṭyatijagatīdhṛtaya ādyā upādyāścatasro*

vāruṇyaśca veti | maṃḍaladraṣṭā vāmadevarṣiḥ | prathamā catuḥṣaṣṭyakṣarāṣṭirdvitīyā
dvipaṃcāśadakṣarātijagatī tṛtīyā dvisaptatyakṣarā dhṛtiścaturthādyā anādeśaparibhāṣayā
saptadaśa triṣṭubhaḥ | kṛtsasya sūktasya maṃḍalādiṣṭāgneyamiti paribhāṣayāgnirdevatā
dvitīyādyāścatasro varuṇadevatyā vā ‖ sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ‖ ādyādhyāyo
pākaraṇe maṃḍalādihome viniyuktā ‖
anuvādavu—vāmadevarṣidṛṣṭavāda ī nālkanèya maṃḍaladalli aidu anuvākagaḷiruvavu
avugaḷalli mòdalanèya anuvākadalli hattu sūktagaḷiruvavu. ā hattu sūktagaḷalli tvāṃ hyagne
sadamit èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèyadu. idaralli ippattu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. anukramaṇikèyalli—
tvāṃ hyagne viṃśatiraṣṭṛtijagatīdhṛtaya ādyā upādyāścatasro vāruṇyaśca nā èṃdu
heḷiruvudu. ī sūktakkè maṃḍaladraṣṭṛvāda vāmadevane ṛṣiyu ; ī sūktadalli aravattunālku
akṣaragaḷuḷḷa mòdalanèya ṛkku aṣṭi èṃba chaṃdassinadu ; aivattèraḍu akṣaragaḷuḷḷa èraḍanèya ṛkku
atijagatīchaṃdaskavu ; èppattèraḍu akṣaragaḷuḷḷa mūranèya ṛkku dhṛti èṃba chaṃdassinadu ; nālkanèya
ṛkkiniṃda sūktada kònèyavarègina hadineḷu ṛkkugaḷū triṣṭup chaṃdaskavu. maṃḍalādiṣṭāgneyaṃ—maṃḍalada prāraṃbhada sūktavu agni devatākavāgiruvudu èṃba paribhāṣèganusāravāgi
ī mòdalanèya pūrtā sūktakkè agniyu devatèyu ; èraḍanèya ṛkkiniṃda nālku ṛkkugaḷigè
(2-5 ṛkkugaḷigè) agni athavā varuṇanu devatèyu. sūktaviniyogavu laiṃgikavu. ī sūktada
mòdalanèya ṛkkannu adhyāyotsarjana upākarmahomagaḷalli maṃḍalahomakkāgi viniyogi
suva rūḍhi iruvudu.

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the fourth maṇḍala, called Vāmadevya, there are five anuvākas. In the first anuvāka there are ten sūktas. Among them the first is the sūkta of twenty ṛks beginning त्वां ह्यग्ने सदमित् (*tvāṃ hyagne sadamit*). He cites the Anukramaṇikā: the twenty ṛks beginning त्वां ह्यग्ने (*tvāṃ hyagne*) are in the metres aṣṭi, atijagatī and dhṛti, and the Vāruṇī ṛks are mentioned there.[?341]. The seer is Vāmadeva, the seer of the maṇḍala. The first ṛk has sixty-four syllables and is aṣṭi; the second has fifty-two syllables and is atijagatī; the third has seventy-two syllables and is dhṛti. By the rule of unspecified cases, the seventeen from the fourth are triṣṭubh. The deity of the whole sūkta is Agni, by the rule that the first sūkta of a maṇḍala is Āgneya; or else the second and the following four ṛks have Varuṇa as deity. The use of the sūkta is that stated in the Liṅga (laiṅgika). The first ṛk is employed in the Maṇḍala-ādi homa in connection with the Adhyāya-upākaraṇa.[?342]

Anuvāda (Kannada, within the same block): In this fourth maṇḍala, seen by the Vāmadeva Ṛṣi, there are five anuvākas. In the first anuvāka there are ten sūktas. Of these ten, this sūkta beginning त्वां ह्यग्ने सदमित् (*tvāṃ hyagne sadamit*) is the first. It has twenty ṛks. In the Anukramaṇikā it is stated: त्वां ह्यग्ने विंशतिरष्टृतिजगतीधृतय आद्या उपाद्याश्चतस्रो वारुण्यश्च ना (*tvāṃ hyagne viṃśatiraṣṭṛtijagatīdhṛtaya ādyā upādyāścatasro vāruṇyaśca nā*). The seer of this sūkta is Vāmadeva, the seer of the maṇḍala. In this sūkta the first ṛk, of sixty-four syllables, is in the metre called aṣṭi; the second, of fifty-two syllables, is in atijagatī; the third, of seventy-two syllables, is in the metre called dhṛti; and the seventeen ṛks from the fourth to the end of the sūkta are in triṣṭubh. According to the rule मंडलादिष्टाग्नेयं (*maṃḍalādiṣṭāgneyaṃ*), that the opening sūkta of a maṇḍala has Agni as deity, Agni is the deity of this whole first sūkta; for the four ṛks from the second (ṛks 2-5) the deity is Agni or Varuṇa. The use of the sūkta is that stated in the Liṅga. It is the custom to employ the first ṛk of this sūkta for the Maṇḍala-homa in the Adhyāyotsarjana and Upākarma homas.

> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त–१
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—१ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—१२, १३, १४, १५ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—२० ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—१, ६–२० अग्निः । २–५. अग्निरग्निर्वा वरुणश्च ॥
> छंदः—१. अष्टिः । २. अतिजगती । ३. धृतिः । ४–२०.
> त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta-1*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—1 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—12, 13, 14, 15 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—20 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—1, 6-20 agniḥ | 2-5. agniragnirvā varuṇaśca ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—1. aṣṭiḥ | 2. atijagatī | 3. dhṛtiḥ | 4-20.*
> *triṣṭup ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वां ह्यं॑ग्ने॒ सद॒मित्सं॑म॒न्यवो॑ दे॒वासो॑ दे॒वमं॑र॒तिं न्यें॑रि॒
र इति॒ क्रत्वा॑ न्येरि॒रे ।
अम॑र्त्यं यज॒त मर्त्ये॒ष्वा दे॒वमादे॑वं जन॒त प्रचे॑तसं॒
विश्व॒मादे॑वं जन॒त प्रचे॑तसम् ॥ १ ॥

> *tvāṃ hyagne sadamitsamanyavo devāso devamaratiṃ nyerira iti kratvā nyerire |*
> *amartyaṃ yajata martyeṣvā devamādevaṃ janata pracetasaṃ*
> *viśvamādevaṃ janata pracetasam ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वां । हि । अग्ने । सदं । इत् । समन्यवः । देवासः । देवं । अरतिं । निएरिरे ।
> इति । क्रत्वा । निएरिरे ।
> अमर्त्यं । यजत । मर्त्येषु । आ । देवं । आदेवं । जनत । प्रचेतसं । विश्वं ।
> आदेवं । जनत । प्रचेतसं ॥ १ ॥

> *tvāṃ | hi | agne | sadaṃ | it | samanyavaḥ | devāsaḥ | devaṃ | aratiṃ | nierire |*
> *iti | kratvā | nierire |*
> *amartyaṃ | yajata | martyeṣu | ā | devaṃ | ādevaṃ | janata | pracetasaṃ | viśvaṃ |*
> *ādevaṃ | janata | pracetasaṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> नामदेवः स्तौति । हे अग्ने समन्यवः । मन्युः स्पर्धा । तया सह वर्तमानाः । स्वसमानैः स्पर्धामाना इत्यर्थः । देवासो देवनशीला इंद्रादयो
> देवा देवं द्योतमानमरतिं शीघ्रं गंतारं त्वां सदमित्सदैव नैरिरे हि। स्पर्धानिमित्ते युद्धे प्रेरयंति खुलु । इतिशब्दो हेत्वर्थः । यस्माद्देवास्तां
> युद्धार्थं नितरां प्रेरयंति तस्माद्यजमानाः क्रत्वा स्तुतिलक्षेन कर्मणा नैरिरे ।
> यज्ञकर्मणि देवान्हविः प्रापयितुं देवानाह्वातुं च त्वां नितरां प्रेरयंति
> खलु । यजत यजनीय हे अग्ने अमर्त्यं मरणधर्मरहितमा सर्वतो देवं
> द्योतमानं प्रचेतसं । प्रकृष्टं कर्मविषयं चेतो ज्ञानं यस्य तादृशं त्वां
> मर्त्येषु यागं कुर्वाणेषु मनुष्येष्वादेवनागंतारं जनत । देवा हविःश्रपणार्थमजनयन् । तथा प्रचेतसं कर्माभिज्ञमादेवं तत्तद्यज्ञेष्टागंतारं त्वां
> विश्वं जनत । युगपन्नानादेशवर्तिषु यज्ञेषु यौगपद्येन हविरानयनार्थं
> व्याप्तं देवा अकुर्वन् ॥ नैरिरे । ईर गतौ । लिट मंत्रत्वादान्नु भवति । सहेति
> योगविभागात्समासः । हियोगादनिघातः । क्रत्वा । जसादिषु छंदसि वावचनमिति
> नादेशाभावः । यणादेशः ॥

> *nāmadevaḥ stauti | he agne samanyavaḥ | manyuḥ spardhā | tayā saha vartamānāḥ | svasamānaiḥ spardhāmānā ityarthaḥ | devāso devanaśīlā iṃdrādayo*
> *devā devaṃ dyotamānamaratiṃ śīghraṃ gaṃtāraṃ tvāṃ sadamitsadaiva nairire hi| spardhānimitte yuddhe prerayaṃti khulu | itiśabdo hetvarthaḥ | yasmāddevāstāṃ*
> *yuddārthaṃ nitarāṃ prerayaṃti tasmādyajamānāḥ kratvā stutilakṣena karmaṇā nairire |*

> *yajñakarmaṇi devānhaviḥ prāpayituṃ devānāhvātuṃ ca tvāṃ nitarāṃ prerayaṃti*
> *khalu | yajata yajanīya he agne amartyaṃ maraṇadharmarahitamā sarvato devaṃ*
> *dyotamānaṃ pracetasaṃ | prakṛṣṭaṃ karmaviṣayaṃ ceto jñānaṃ yasya tādṛśaṃ tvāṃ*
> *martyeṣu yāgaṃ kurvāṇeṣu manuṣyèṣvādevanāgaṃtāraṃ janata | devā haviḥśrapaṇārthamajanayan | tathā pracetasaṃ karmābhijñamādevaṃ tattadyajñèṣṭāgaṃtāraṃ tvāṃ*
> *viśvaṃ janata | yugapannānādeśavartiṣu yajñeṣu yaugapadyena havirānayanārthaṃ*
> *vyāptaṃ devā akurvan ‖ nairire | īra gatau | liṭa maṃtratvādānnu bhavati | saheti*
> *yogavibhāgātsamāsaḥ | hiyogādanighātaḥ | kratvā | jasādiṣu chaṃdasi vāvacanamiti*
> *nādeśābhāvaḥ | yaṇādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

Vāmadeva praises. O Agni, the gods are समन्यवः (*samanyavaḥ*): manyu is rivalry, so "existing together with it", that is, rivalling their own equals. The gods, the Indras and others who are of shining nature, ever (सदमित् (*sadamit*), "always") urge you, who are shining and swift-going (अरतिं (*aratiṃ*)), into battle that arises from rivalry. The word इति (*iti*) has the sense of cause: because the gods urge you strongly for battle, therefore the sacrificers also urge you strongly, by क्रत्वा (*kratvā*), the act of praise, in the sacrificial rite, to convey the oblation to the gods and to call the gods. O adorable Agni, you who are immortal, free from the nature of death, shining on every side, प्रचेतसं (*pracetasaṃ*), one whose mind or knowledge concerning rites is excellent: the gods generated you as one who comes to men who perform sacrifice (मर्त्येषु (*martyeṣu*)), आदेवं (*ādevaṃ*), to cook the oblation. Likewise, knowing the rites and coming to this and that sacrifice, the gods made you विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*), pervading, so as to bring the oblation at one and the same time to sacrifices taking place in different regions.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- समन्यवः (*samanyavaḥ*)—rivalling one another
- देवासः (*devāsaḥ*)—the gods
- देवं (*devaṃ*)—shining
- अरतिं (*aratiṃ*)—swift-moving
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—always
- नैरिरे हि (*nairire hi*)—urge (to battle), do they not? (for that very reason the sacrificers also)
- क्रत्वा (*kratvā*)—by the act in the form of praise
- नैरिरे (*nairire*)—urge (you, in order to call the gods)
- यजत (*yajata*)—Agni, worthy of sacrifice
- अमर्त्यं (*amartyaṃ*)—deathless
- आ (*ā*)—everywhere
- देवं (*devaṃ*)—shining
- प्रचेतसं (*pracetasaṃ*)—possessed of excellent knowledge, you
- मर्त्येषु (*martyeṣu*)—among men who perform sacrifice
- आदेवं (*ādevaṃ*)—as one who always comes
- जनत (*janata*)—(the gods) have known
- प्रचेतसं (*pracetasaṃ*)—possessed of knowledge of rites
- आदेवं (*ādevaṃ*)—one who comes for each sacrifice, you
- विश्वं जनत (*viśvaṃ janata*)—made you pervade the world and take part in all sacrifices

Gist

O Agni, the gods, rivalling one another, always urge you, who are shining and swift-moving, to battle. For that same reason the sacrificers too, by the act in the form of praise, urge you for the calling of the gods. O Agni, worthy of sacrifice, the gods have known you, deathless, shining everywhere and possessed of excellent knowledge, as dwelling among men who perform sacrifice. You, who have knowledge concerning rites and who come for each sacrifice, those gods made all-pervading, so as to take part in all sacrifices.

English translation

Since the emuolus gods ever excite you, Agni, who is a deity swift of motion, (to contest), therefore do (your worshippers) urge you by their devotions (to bring the deities to their sacrifices) : adorable Agni, they (the deities), have generated you, immortal, divine, all-wise, as the present divinity among men : they have generated you as the all-wise deity.

Special Topics

The first ṛk of this sūkta is in the metre called aṣṭi. The second ṛk is in atijagatī and the third in the metre called dhṛti. The peculiarity of these ṛks is that one or two words at the end of the first half and of the second half of the ṛk (of the last half, where a ṛk has three halves) are recited twice. That is, they are not recited twice in one place; one or two words stand between them. For example, in नैरिर इति क्रत्वा नैरिरे (*nairira iti kratvā nairire*) the word नैरिरे (*nairire*) is recited twice, and between these words stand the words इति क्रत्वा (*iti kratvā*). It is the same in प्रचेतसं विश्वमादेवं जनत प्रचेतसं (*pracetasaṃ viśvamādevaṃ janata pracetasaṃ*). Such rhyme is used with the purpose that it be pleasant to the ear when recited. The Bhāṣyakāra, however, in some places explains a separate meaning for the words recited twice. This kind of metre and rhyme is found especially in the sūktas seen by the seer Paruchchhepa, son of Divodāsa, that is, in sūktas 127-139 of the first maṇḍala.

समन्यवः—मन्युः स्पर्धा । तया सह वर्तमानाः । स्वसमानैः स्पर्धमाना इत्यर्थः । (*samanyavaḥ—manyuḥ spardhā | tayā saha vartamānāḥ | svasamānaiḥ spardhamānā ityarthaḥ* |) Although the word manyu has the meanings of anger and wrath, here the Bhāṣyakāra explains it as spardhā (contest) and gives the meaning "those who rival one another among themselves." This word is an adjective of the word देवासः (*devāsaḥ*).

अरतिं—शीघ्रं गंतारं । (*aratiṃ—śīghraṃ gaṃtāraṃ* |) For this word, formed from the root य गतौ (*ya gatau*), the meaning "one who has swift movement" is given.

इति (*iti*)—The word इति (*iti*) is used here in the sense of cause (the sense "therefore").

Pracetasam: one whose cognition (cetas, jñāna) concerning ritual action is excellent; that is, one who knows rites well. The meaning is: one who has proper understanding in sacrificial performances and the like.

Viśvaṃ janata: although many sacrificers in various parts of the country perform sacrifices at the same time, Agni, in his many forms, takes part in the sacrificial act in all of them at once and has the power to bring it to successful completion. In this Ṛk the seer Vāmadeva explains that this all-pervading power came to Agni from the gods.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स भ्रात॑र॒ं वरु॑णमग्न॒ आ व॑वृत्स्व दे॒वाँ अच्छा॑ सुम॒
ती य॒ज्ञव॑नस॒ं ज्येष्ठ᳚ं य॒ज्ञव॑नसम् ।
ऋ॒तावा॑नमादि॒त्यं च॑र्षणी॒धृत॒ं राजा॑नं चर्षणी॒धृत॑म् ॥
२ ॥

> *sa bhrātaraṃ varuṇamagna ā vavṛtsva devā~ acchā sumatī*
> *yajñavanasaṃ jyeṣṭhaṃ yajñavanasam |*
> *ṛtāvānamādityaṃ carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ rājānaṃ carṣaṇīdhṛtam ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । भ्रातरं । वरुणं । अग्ने । आ । ववृत्स्व । देवान् । अच्छ । सुमती । यज्ञवनसं । ज्येष्ठं ।
> यज्ञवनसं ॥
> ऋतवानं । आदित्यं । चर्षणीधृतं । राजानं । चर्षणीधृतं ॥ २ ॥

> *saḥ | bhrātaram | varuṇam | agne | ā | vavṛtsva | devān | accha |*
> *sumatī | yajñavanasaṃ | jyeṣṭhaṃ | yajñavanasaṃ ‖*
> *ṛtavānaṃ | ādityaṃ | carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ | rājānaṃ | carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने स तादृशस्त्वं भ्रातरमेकस्थानवासेन भ्रातरं वरुणं । वृणोत्युदकमिति वरुणः । तं देवं यज्ञवनसं यज्ञैर्वननीयैर्हविर्भिः संभजनीयं
> यज्ञवनसं च यज्ञस्य संभक्तारं ज्येष्ठमतिशयेन प्रशस्यमृतावानमपां स्वामितयोदकवंतं सत्यवंतं ना आदित्यमदितेः पुत्रं चर्षणीधृतं मनुष्याणामुदकप्रदानेन धारकं सुमती शोभनबुद्ध्या हेतुना चर्षणीधृतं चर्षणिभिर्विद्वद्भिर्धृतं राजानं राजंतं एतादृशं वरुणं देवं देवान् देवनशीलान् स्तोत्थनच्छाभ्या ववृत्स्व । आवर्तय । अभिमुखीकुरु ॥ ववृत्स्व । वृतु वर्तने । लोट

> *he agne sa tādṛśastvaṃ bhrātaramekasthānavāsena bhrātaraṃ varuṇaṃ | vṛṇotyudakamiti varuṇaḥ | taṃ devaṃ yajñavanasaṃ yajñairvananīyairhavirbhiḥ saṃbhajanīyaṃ*
> *yajñavanasaṃ ca yajñasya saṃbhaktāraṃ jyeṣṭhamatiśayena praśasyamṛtāvānamapāṃ svāmitayodakavaṃtaṃ satyavaṃtaṃ nā ādityamaditeḥ putraṃ carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ manuṣyāṇāmudakapradānena dhārakaṃ sumatī śobhanabuddhyā hetunā carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ carṣaṇibhirvidvadbhirdhṛtaṃ rājānaṃ rājaṃtaṃ etādṛśaṃ varuṇaṃ devaṃ devān devanaśīlān stotthanacchābhyā vavṛtsva | āvartaya | abhimukhīkuru ‖ vavṛtsva | vṛtu vartane | loṭa*

> बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य श्लुः । निघातः । सुमती । मंत्रे वृषेत्यादिना क्तिन्नुदात्तः । सुपां सुलुगिति तृतीयायाः पूर्वसवर्णदीर्घः । एकादेशस्वरः । ज्येष्ठं ।
> प्रशस्यस्येष्टनि ज्य चेति ज्यादेशः । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः । एकादेशस्वरः । यज्ञवनसं ।
> वन षण संभक्तौ । कर्मकर्तरि चासुन्प्रत्ययः । गतिकारकयोरपि पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरत्वं चेति पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya śluḥ | nighātaḥ | sumatī | maṃtre vṛṣetyādinā ktinnudāttaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti tṛtīyāyāḥ pūrvasavarṇadīrghaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ | jyeṣṭhaṃ |*
> *praśasyasyèṣṭani jya ceti jyādeśaḥ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ | yajñavanasaṃ |*
> *vana ṣaṇa saṃbhaktau | karmakartari cāsunpratyayaḥ |*
> *gatikārakayorapi pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaratvaṃ ceti pūrvapadasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, being such, turn towards us the gods' Varuṇa, a brother by dwelling in one place. Varuṇa is so called because he covers (vṛṇoti) the water. He is the god to be shared in by sacrifices, that is, by

oblations that are to be enjoyed; a sharer in the sacrifice; the eldest, most praiseworthy; ṛtāvan, possessing water as lord of the waters, and truthful; Āditya, son of Aditi; supporter of men (carṣaṇi) by giving them water; sumatī, "with good intelligence", as the reason; supported by the carṣaṇis, the learned; a king, shining. Turn such a Varuṇa towards the gods, the shining ones, by praise and by our wish. Vavṛtsva is from vṛtu in the sense of turning, in the imperative.

Grammar of the words of the verse (the Grammar section carries it).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- सः (*saḥ*)—you, the well-known
- भ्रातरं (*bhrātaraṃ*)—one who is a brother to you
- यज्ञवनसं (*yajñavanasaṃ*)—one worshipped with oblations
- यज्ञवनसं (*yajñavanasaṃ*)—one who takes a share in the sacrifice
- ज्येष्ठं (*jyeṣṭhaṃ*)—the praiseworthy
- ऋतावानं (*ṛtāvānaṃ*)—the truthful
- आदित्यं (*ādityaṃ*)—son of Aditi
- चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*)—supporter of men
- सुमती (*sumatī*)—with excellent intelligence
- चर्षणीधृतं (*carṣaṇīdhṛtaṃ*)—one held in meditation in the minds of men
- राजानं (*rājānaṃ*)—lord of the universe
- वरुणं (*varuṇaṃ*)—Varuṇa the god
- देवान् (*devān*)—to the worshippers
- अच्छ (*accha*)—facing them
- आ ववृत्स् (*ā vavṛts*)—bring

Gist

O Agni, you, the well-known, bring Varuṇa, who is a brother to you, worshipped with oblations, a sharer in the sacrifice, praiseworthy, truthful, son of Aditi, supporter of men, held with excellent intelligence in meditation in the minds of men, and lord of the universe, to face the worshippers.

English translation

Bring to the presence of the worshippers, Agni, your brother Varuna, as a participator of the sacrifice, with a willing mind, the elder participator of the sacrifice ; the ruler of the water, the Aditya, the supporter of men, the sovereign venerated by mankind.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk Agni is asked to bring Varuṇa, son of Aditi, to the sacrifice.

Bhrātaram: how is Varuṇa a brother to Agni? It is proper to say that Agni, Indra and the other gods, and Varuṇa are brothers. This matter is stated in:

अष्टौ पुत्रासो अदिशेः । ये जातास्तन्वःपरि । देवा उपप्रैत्सस्तभिः । परामार्तांडमास्यत् । सप्तभिः पुत्रैरदितिः। उपप्रैत्सूर्व्यं युगं । प्रजायै मृत्यनेतत् । परामार्तांडमा भरदिति ।ताननुक्रमिष्यामः । मित्रश्च वरुणश्च । धाता चार्यमा च । अगंशश्च भगश्च । इंद्रश्च विवस्वाग् श्चेत्येते ॥ (*aṣṭau putrāso adiśeḥ | ye jātāstanvaḥpari | devā upapraitsastabhiḥ | parāmārtāṃḍamāsyat | saptabhiḥ putrairaditiḥ| upapraitsūrvyaṃ yugaṃ | prajāyai mṛtyanetat | parāmārtāṃḍamā bharaditi | tānanukramiṣyāmaḥ | mitraśca varuṇaśca | dhātā cāryamā ca | agaṃśaśca bhagaśca | iṃdraśca vivasvāg ścetyete ‖*) (Kṛ. Ā. 1-13-2)

Aditi is said to have eight sons: Mitra, Varuṇa, Dhātā, Aryamā, Aṃśa, Bhaga, Indra and Vivasvān. In many places it is said that Agni is in heaven as Āditya or the sun, and it is well known that Āditya is one of Agni's three forms. Therefore the fact that Agni and Varuṇa are brothers is indicated here by the word bhrātaram.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सखे॒ सखा॑यम॒भ्या व॑वृत्स्वा॒शुं न च॒क्रं रथ्यै॑व॒ रंह्या॒स्मभ्यं॑ दस्म॒ रंह्या॑ ।
अग्ने॑ मृळी॒कं वरु॑णे॒ सचा॑ विदो म॒रुत्सु॑ वि॒श्वभा॑नुषु ।
तो॒काय॑ तु॒जे शु॑शुचान॒ शं कृ॑ध्य॒स्मभ्यं॑ दस्म॒ शं कृ॑धि ॥ ३ ॥

> *sakhe sakhāyamabhyā vavṛtsvāśuṃ na cakraṃ rathyeva*
> *raṃhyāsmabhyaṃ dasma raṃhyā |*
> *agne mṛḷīkaṃ varuṇe sacā vido marutsu viśvabhānuṣu |*
> *tokāya tuje śuśucāna śaṃ kṛdhyasmabhyaṃ dasma śaṃ kṛdhi ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सखे । सखायं । अभि । आ । ववृत्स्व । आशुं । न । चक्रं । रथ्या इव । रंह्या ।
> अस्मभ्यं । दस्म । रंह्या ।
> अग्ने । मृळीकं । वरुणे । सचा । विदः । मरुत्सु । विश्वभानुषु ।
> तोकाय । तुजे । शुशुचान । शम् । कृधि । अस्मभ्यं । दस्म । शं । कृधि ॥ ३ ॥

> *sakhe | sakhāyaṃ | abhi | ā | vavṛtsva | āśuṃ | na | cakraṃ | rathyā iva | raṃhyā |*
> *asmabhyaṃ | dasma | raṃhyā |*
> *agne | mṛḷīkaṃ | varuṇe | sacā | vidaḥ | marutsu | viśvabhānuṣu |*
> *tokāya | tuje | śuśucāna | śam | kṛdhi | asmabhyaṃ | dasma | śaṃ | kṛdhi ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रवर्ज्येऽभिष्टव उत्तरस्मिन्पटले सखे सखायमित्येषा । सूत्रितं च । सखे सखायमभ्या ववृत्सोद्वर्ष ऊ षु ण ऊतये । आ. ४–७ । इति ॥

> *pravarjye 'bhiṣṭava uttarasminpaṭale sakhe sakhāyamityeṣā | sūtritaṃ ca | sakhe*
> *sakhāyamabhyā vavṛtsodvarṣa ū ṣu ṇa ūtaye | ā. 4-7 | iti ‖*

> सखे सखिभूत दस्म दर्शनीय हे अग्ने त्वं तव सखायं वरुणमस्मभ्यमस्मदर्थमा ववृत्स्व । अभिमुखीकुरु । तत्र दृष्टांतः । रंह्या रंहणे गमने
> साधुभूतौ रथ्येव रथे योजितावश्वा यथाशुं शीघ्रगंतृ चक्रं लक्ष्यदेशं प्रत्यभिमुखीकुरुतस्तद्वत् । हे अग्ने सचा तव सहाये वरुणे मृळीकं सुखकरं हविर्विदः । लब्धवानसि । तथा विश्वभानुषु सर्वतो व्याप्ततेजस्केषु मरुत्तु सुखकरं
> लब्धवानसि । आग्निवारुणाग्निमारुतयोः कर्मणोरिष्टवानसीत्यर्थः । शुशुचान
> दीप्यमान हे अग्ने तोकाय । तुज्यते पीड्यतेऽनेन माता गर्भवासेनेति तोकं
> पुत्रः । तस्मै तुजे । गच्छत्यनेनान्यं पितेति तुक् पौत्रः । तस्मै शं सुखं कृधि ।
> कुरु । दस्म दर्शनीय हे अग्ने असभ्यं शं कृधि । सुखं कुरु ॥ रथ्येव । रथस्येमावित्यर्थे रथाद्यदिति यत् । सुपां सुलुगिति सुपो डादेशः । रंह्या । रंहशब्दात्तत्र
> साधुरिति यत्पत्ययः । यतोऽनाव इत्याद्युदात्तत्वं ॥

> *sakhe sakhibhūta dasma darśanīya he agne tvaṃ tava sakhāyaṃ varuṇamasmabhyamasmadarthamā vavṛtsva | abhimukhīkuru | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | raṃhyā raṃhaṇe gamane*
> *sādhubhūtau rathyeva rathe yojitāvaśvā yathāśuṃ śīghragaṃtṛ cakraṃ lakṣyadeśaṃ pratyabhimukhīkurutastadvat | he agne sacā tava sahāye varuṇe mṛḻīkaṃ sukhakaraṃ havirvidaḥ | labdhavānasi | tathā viśvabhānuṣu sarvato vyāptatejaskeṣu maruttu sukhakaraṃ*
> *labdhavānasi | āgnivāruṇāgnimārutayoḥ karmaṇoriṣṭavānasītyarthaḥ | śuśucāna*
> *dīpyamāna he agne tokāya | tujyate pīḍyate 'nena mātā garbhavāseneti tokaṃ*
> *putraḥ | tasmai tuje | gacchatyanenānyaṃ piteti tuk pautraḥ | tasmai śaṃ sukhaṃ kṛdhi |*
> *kuru | dasma darśanīya he agne asabhyaṃ śaṃ kṛdhi | sukhaṃ kuru ‖*
> *rathyeva | rathasyèmāvityarthe rathādyaditi yat | supāṃ sulugiti supo ḍādeśaḥ | raṃhyā | raṃhaśabdāttatra*
> *sādhuriti yatpatyayaḥ | yato 'nāva ityādyudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

In the Pravargya, in the later paṭala of the Abhiṣṭava, the verse *sakhe sakhāyam* is used. It is also stated in the sūtra: सखे सखायमभ्या ववृत्सोद्वर्ष ऊ षु ण ऊतये (*sakhe sakhāyamabhyā vavṛtsodvarṣa ū ṣu ṇa ūtaye*) (Ā. 4-7).

O Agni, friend, beautiful one, turn your friend Varuṇa towards us, for our sake. The example: as two good-going horses yoked to a chariot bring the swift wheel (chariot) facing the goal. O Agni, with Varuṇa, your companion, you have obtained the pleasing oblation; likewise with the Maruts, whose splendour pervades everywhere, you have obtained it. The sense: you have offered in the rites of Agni-Varuṇa and Agni-Māruta. O shining Agni, to toka, the son (so called because the mother is troubled (tujyate) by him in dwelling in the womb), to tuj, that is tuk, the grandson (by whom the father goes elsewhere), make happiness. O beautiful Agni, make happiness for us. Remaining grammatical notes omitted.

Word-to-word meaning

- सखे (*sakhe*)—O one who is a friend
- दस्म (*dasma*)—O beautiful Agni
- रंह्या (*raṃhyā*)—having excellent movement
- रथ्येव (*rathyeva*)—the horses
- आशुं (*āśuṃ*)—swift
- चक्रं न (*cakraṃ na*)—as they carry the chariot (to a fixed place)
- सखायं (*sakhāyaṃ*)—our friend Varuṇa
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—for our purpose
- आ ववृत्स्य (*ā vavṛtsya*)—bring
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- वरुणे सचा (*varuṇe sacā*)—together with Varuṇa
- मृळीकं (*mṛḷīkaṃ*)—the pleasing oblation
- विदः (*vidaḥ*)—you have obtained
- विश्वभानुषु (*viśvabhānuṣu*)—those of all-pervading splendour
- मरुत्तु (*maruttu*)—with the Maruts (also you have obtained)
- शुशुचान (*śuśucāna*)—O shining Agni
- तोकाय (*tokāya*)—for our sons

- तुजे (*tuje*)—for our grandsons
- शं (*śaṃ*)—happiness
- कृधि (*kṛdhi*)—make
- दस्म (*dasma*)—O Agni of attractive form
- अस्मभ्यं (*asmabhyaṃ*)—for us
- शं (*śaṃ*)—happiness
- कृधि (*kṛdhi*)—make

Gist

O Agni, friend and beautiful one, as horses of excellent movement carry the swift chariot to a fixed place, bring quickly our friend Varuṇa for our purpose. O Agni, you have obtained pleasing oblations with Varuṇa and with the Maruts of all-pervading splendour. O shining Agni, make happiness for our sons, our grandsons and ourselves.

English translation

Friendly and beautiful (Agni), bring your friend (Varuna) to our presence, as two strong horses conyey the swift chariot along the road to Vol. 17 [43]

its goal : you receive, Agni, the gratifying (oblation) together with Varuna , and with the all-illumining Maruts : grant, brilliant Agni, happiness to our sons and grandsons ; grant, beautiful Agni, happiness to ourselves.

Special Topics

The commentator has explained the component meaning of the words toka and tuj in this Ṛk:

Tokāya: तुज्यते पीड्यतेऽनेन माता गर्भवासेनेति तोकं पुत्रः तस्मै । (*tujyate pīḍyate 'nena mātā garbhavāseneti tokaṃ putraḥ tasmai |*) The root tuj means "to harm". Of the word toka derived from it, the meaning is that since a son harms the mother both while in the womb and at the time of birth, the son is called toka.

Tuje: गच्छत्यनेनानृण्यं पितेति तुक् पौत्रः । तस्मै । (*gacchatyanenānṛṇyaṃ piteti tuk pautraḥ* | *tasmai* |) Tuk means the grandson. Through him, that is, through his birth, the father clears his debt, that is, becomes anṛṇa (free of debt). In the Tai. Saṃhitā it is said: जायमानो वै ब्राह्मणस्त्रिभिर्यणवा जायते ब्रह्मचर्येण ऋषिभ्यो यज्ञेन देवेभ्यः प्रजया पितृभ्य एष वा अनृणो यः पुत्री यज्वा ब्रह्मचारिवासी (*jāyamāno vai brāhmaṇastribhiryaṇavā jāyate brahmacaryeṇa ṛṣibhyo yajñena devebhyaḥ prajayā pitṛbhya eṣa vā anṛṇo yaḥ putrī yajvā brahmacārivāsī*)?344. That is, a Brāhmaṇa is born with three kinds of debts: the debt to the seers, to the gods and to the fathers. They are repaid thus: by living in the teacher's house under the rule of brahmacarya and studying the Veda, the debt to the seers is repaid. By performing sacrifices as a householder and pleasing the gods, the debt to the gods is repaid. By begetting offspring in his lawful wife after marriage, the debt to the fathers is repaid. Therefore a Brāhmaṇa who repays these three debts in the manner stated is called anṛṇa. By offspring such as sons and grandsons, one of the debts mentioned is repaid. Hence the commentator explains here that son and grandson make their father anṛṇa, free of debt.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वं नो॑ अ॒ग्ने वरु॑णस्य वि॒द्वान्दे॒वस्य॒ हेळोऽव॑ यासिसीष्ठाः ।
यजि॑ष्ठो॒ वह्नि॑तम॒ः शोशु॑चानो॒ विश्वा॒ द्वेषां॑सि॒ प्र मु॑मुग्ध्य॒स्मत् ॥ ४ ॥

> *tvaṃ no agne varuṇasya vidvāndevasya heḷo 'va yāsisīṣṭhāḥ |*
> *yajiṣṭho vahnitamaḥ śośucāno viśvā dveṣāṃsi pra mumugdhyasmat ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । नः । अग्ने । वरुणस्य । विद्वान् । देवस्य । हेळः । अव । यासिसीष्ठाः ।
> यजिष्ठः । वह्नितमः । शोशुचानः । विश्वा । द्वेषांसि । प्र । मुमुग्धि । अस्मत् ॥ ४ ॥

> *tvaṃ | naḥ | agne | varuṇasya | vidvān | devasya | heḷaḥ | ava | yāsisīṣṭhāḥ |*
> *yajiṣṭhaḥ | vahnitamaḥ | śośucānaḥ | viśvā | dveṣāṃsi | pra | mumugni | asmat ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> त्वं नो अग्न इत्येतदारभ्येदं सूक्तमुत्तराणि सूक्तानि च प्रातरनुवाक
> आग्नेये क्रत् त्रैष्टुभे छंदस्याश्विनशस्त्रे च विनियुक्तानि । सूत्रितं च । त्वं नो
> अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वानित्येतत्पृथ्वीनि चत्वारि । आ. ४–१३ । इति ॥ अवभृथेष्टां
> स्विष्टकृदर्थेऽग्निवरुणौ यष्टव्या । तत्र त्वं नो अग्न इति द्वे याज्यानुवाक्ये । सूत्रितं
> च । अग्नीवरुणौ स्विष्टकृदर्थे त्वं नो अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वानिति द्वे । आ. ६–१३ । इति ॥
> अस्नातो यद्यग्निहोत्रं जुहुयात्तदाग्नि वारुणीष्टिः । तस्यामेते एव याज्यानुवाक्ये । तदाहुर्य
> आहिताग्निरित्युपक्रम्याम्नातं । तस्य याज्यानुवाक्ये त्वं नो
> अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वान्त्स त्वं नो अग्नेऽवमो भवोती । ऐ. ब्रा. ७–९ । इति ॥
> हे अग्ने विद्वान् सर्वपुरुषार्थसाधनोपायज्ञस्त्वं देवस्य द्योतमानस्य
> वरुणस्य हेळः क्रोधान् नोऽस्मत्संबधिनो वरुणकर्तृकान्पाशग्रहणानव यासिसीष्ठाः । अपनय
> । किंच यजिष्टो यष्टृतमो वह्नितमो हविषामतिशयेन
> वोढा शोशुचानोऽतिशयेन दीप्यमानस्त्वं विश्वा सर्वाणि द्वेषांसि पापानि
> द्वेष्टणि रजांसि वा अस्मदस्मत्तः प्र मुमुग्धि । प्रकर्षेण मोचय ॥ हेळः ।
> हेडृ अनादरे । क्विप् । शसि रूपं । शसः सुस्त्यादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । यासिसीष्ठाः ।
> यसेर्ण्यंतादाशीर्लिज् । थासि सीयुडागमः । छंदस्युभयथेति लिजः
> सार्वधातुकत्वाण्णिलोपाभावः । अवपूर्वो यासिर्विनाशे वर्तते । मुमुग्धि ।
> मुंचतेर्लोटि रूपं । बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः ॥

> *tvaṃ no agna ityetadārabhyedaṃ sūktamuttarāṇi sūktāni ca prātaranuvāka*
> *āgneye krat traiṣṭubhe chaṃdasyāśvinaśastre ca viniyuktāni | sūtritaṃ ca | tvaṃ no*
> *agne varuṇasya vidvānityetatpṛthvīni catvāri | ā. 4-13 | iti ‖*
> *avabhṛtheṣṭāṃ sviṣṭakṛdarthe 'gnivaruṇau yaṣṭavyā | tatra tvaṃ no agna iti dve yājyānuvākye | sūtritaṃ*
> *ca | agnīvaruṇau sviṣṭakṛdarthe tvaṃ no agne varuṇasya vidvāniti dve | ā. 6-13 | iti ‖*

> *asnāto yadyagnihotraṃ juhuyāttadāgni vāruṇīṣṭiḥ | tasyāmete eva yājyānuvākye | tadāhurya āhitāgnirityupakramyānnātaṃ | tasya yājyānuvākye tvaṃ no*
> *agne varuṇasya vidvāntsa tvaṃ no agne 'vamo bhavotī | ai. brā. 7-9 | iti ||*
> *he agne vidvān sarvapuruṣārthasādhanopāyajñastvaṃ devasya dyotamānasya*
> *varuṇasya heḷaḥ krodhān no 'smatsaṃbadhino varuṇakartṛkānpāśagrahaṇānava yāsisīṣṭhāḥ | apanaya | kiṃca yajiṣṭo yaṣṭṛtamo vahnitamo haviṣāmatiśayena*
> *voḍhā śośucāno 'tiśayena dīpyamānastvaṃ viśvā sarvāṇi dveṣāṃsi pāpāni*
> *dveṣṭaṇi rajāṃsi vā asmadasmattaḥ pra mumugdhi | prakarṣeṇa mocaya || heḷaḥ |*
> *heḍṛ anādare | kvip | śasi rūpaṃ | śasaḥ sustyādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | yāsisīṣṭhāḥ | yaserṇyaṃtādāśīrlij | thāsi sīyuḍāgamaḥ | chaṃdasyubhayatheti lijaḥ*
> *sārvadhātukatvāṇṇilopābhāvaḥ | avapūrvo yāsirvināśe vartate | mumugdhi |*
> *muṃcaterloṭi rūpaṃ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ ||*

Summary

Beginning with त्वं नो अग्ने (*tvaṃ no agne*), this sūkta and the following sūktas are applied in the Prātaranuvāka, in the Āgneya kratu, in the Triṣṭubh section and in the Āśvina-śastra. It is stated in the sūtra: त्वं नो अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वानित्येतत्पृथ्वीनि चत्वारि (*tvaṃ no agne varuṇasya vidvānityetatpṛthvīni catvāri*) (Ā. 4-13). In the avabhṛtheṣṭi, Agni and Varuṇa are to be sacrificed to for the Sviṣṭakṛt; there the two verses beginning त्वं नो अग्ने (*tvaṃ no agne*) are the yājyā and anuvākyā. The sūtra: अग्नीवरुणौ स्विष्टकृदर्थे त्वं नो अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वानिति द्वे (*agnīvaruṇau sviṣṭakṛdarthe tvaṃ no agne varuṇasya vidvāniti dve*) (Ā. 6-13). If one unbathed offers the agnihotra, there is the Āgni-Vāruṇī iṣṭi; these same two are its yājyā and anuvākyā; so the Brāhmaṇa says, beginning "he who has set up the fire ... unbathed": its yājyā and anuvākyā are त्वं नो अग्ने वरुणस्य विद्वान् (*tvaṃ no agne varuṇasya vidvān*) and स त्वं नो अग्नेऽवमो भवोती (*sa tvaṃ no agne 'vamo bhavotī*) (Ai. Brā. 7-9).

Meaning: O Agni, knowing the means of accomplishing all human aims, remove from us the wrath of the shining Varuṇa, the seizures by the noose caused by Varuṇa. Further, you, most worshipful, the best carrier of oblations, most brightly shining, release us utterly from all hatreds, that is, sins, the haters, or faults. Remaining notes concern grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—you, the all-knowing
- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of the divine
- वरुणस्य (*varuṇasya*)—Varuṇa's
- हेळेः (*heḷèḥ*)—wrath
- नः (*naḥ*)—from us
- अव यासिसीष्ठाः (*ava yāsisīṣṭhāḥ*)—avert and remove
- यजिष्ठः (*yajiṣṭhaḥ*)—most worshipful
- वह्नि तमः (*vahni tamaḥ*)—greatest bearer of oblations
- शोशुचानः (*śośucānaḥ*)—and shining, you
- विश्वा (*viśvā*)—all
- द्वेषांसि (*dveṣāṃsi*)—sins in the form of enemies
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—from us
- प्र मुमुग्धि (*pra mumugni*)—release and destroy

Gist

O Agni, you who are all-knowing, turn away from us the wrath of Varuṇa, who is the divine being. You who are most worthy of worship, the bearer of the oblation, and resplendent, release us from all sins and destroy them.

English translation

May you, Agni, who are wise, avert from us the wrath of the divine Varuna : you are the most frequent sacrificer, the most diligent bearer (of oblations), the most resplendent, liberate us from all animosities.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स त्वं नो॑ अग्ने॑ऽव॒मो भ॑वो॒ती नेदि॑ष्ठो अ॒स्या उ॒षसो॒ व्यु॑ष्टौ ।
अव॑ यक्ष्व नो॒ वरु॑णं॒ ररा॑णो वी॒हि मृ॑ळी॒कं सु॒हवो॑ न एधि ॥ ५ ॥

> *sa tvaṃ no agne 'vamo bhavotī nediṣṭho asyā uṣaso vyuṣṭau |*
> *ava yakṣva no varuṇaṃ rarāṇo vīhi mṛḷīkaṃ suhavo na edhi ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । त्वं । नः । अग्ने । अवमः । भव । ऊती । नेदिष्ठः । अस्याः । उषसः । विउष्टौ ।
> अव । यक्ष्व । नः । वरुणं । रराणः । वीहि । मृळीकं । सुहवः । नः । विधि ॥ ५ ॥

> *saḥ | tvaṃ | naḥ | agne | avamaḥ | bhava | ūtī | nediṣṭhaḥ | asyāḥ | uṣasaḥ | viuṣṭau |*
> *ava | yakṣva | naḥ | varuṇaṃ | rarāṇaḥ | vīhi | mṛḷīkaṃ | suhavaḥ | naḥ | vidhi ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने स तादृशस्त्वमूती ऊत्या रक्षणेन नोऽस्माकमवमोऽर्वाचीनः
> प्रत्यासन्नः सन् अस्या उषसो व्युष्टौ व्युच्छने प्रातःकालेऽग्निहोत्रादिकर्मसिद्ध्यर्थं नेदिष्टो भव
> । अतिशयेनास्मदंतिकस्थो भव । यद्वा । ऊत्या गमनेनास्माकमवमो रक्षको भव । किंच
> नोऽस्माकु वरुणं वरुणकृतं जलोदरादिरोगं
> आवारकं पापं वा अव यक्ष्व । अवयज । विनाशयेत्यर्थः । रराणोऽस्मदत्ते
> हविषि रममाणः । यद्वा । यजमानेभ्योऽत्यंतमीप्सितफलप्रदस्त्वं मृळीकं

> *he agne sa tādṛśastvamūtī ūtyā rakṣaṇena no 'smākamavamo 'rvācīnaḥ*
> *pratyāsannaḥ san asyā uṣaso vyuṣṭau vyucchane prātaḥkāle*
> *'gnihotrādikarmasiddhyarthaṃ nediṣṭo bhava |*
> *atiśayenāsmadaṃtikastho bhava | yadvā | ūtyā*
> *gamanenāsmākamavamo rakṣako bhava | kiṃca no 'smāku varuṇaṃ*
> *varuṇakṛtaṃ jalodarādirogaṃ*

> *āvārakaṃ pāpaṃ vā ava yakṣva | avayaja | vināśayetyarthaḥ | rarāṇo*
> *'smadatte*
> *haviṣi ramamāṇaḥ | yadvā | yajamānebhyo*
> *'tyaṃtamīpsitaphalapradastvaṃ mṛḷīkaṃ*

> सुखकरमिदं हविर्वीहि । भक्षय । किंच नोऽस्माकं सुहवः शोभनाह्वानोपेत
> ऐधि । भव ॥ नेदिष्टः । अंतिकशब्दा दिष्ठन्यंतिकवाढयोर्नेदसाधाविति नेद इत्यादेशः।
> नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । रराणः । रमतेः कानचि मकारलोपश्चांदसः । यद्वा । रातेर्यज् लुकि
> व्यत्ययेन कानच् । अभ्यस्तानामादिः । एधि । अस्तेर्लोटि ध्वसोरेद्धावभ्यासलोपश्चेति ऐ
> इत्यादेशः । तस्यासिद्धत्वाद्दु झल्भो हेर्धिः । निघातः ॥

> *sukhakaramidaṃ havirvīhi | bhakṣaya | kiṃca no 'smākaṃ suhavaḥ*
> *śobhanāhvānopeta*
> *aidhi | bhava ‖ nediṣṭaḥ | aṃtikaśabdā*
> *diṣṭhanyaṃtikavāḍhayornèdasādhāviti neda ityādeśaḥ|*
> *nittvādādyudāttaḥ | rarāṇaḥ | ramateḥ kānaci makāralopaścāṃdasaḥ |*
> *yadvā | rāteryaj luki vyatyayena kānac | abhyastānāmādiḥ | edhi |*
> *asterloṭi dhvasoreddhāvabhyāsalopaśceti ai ityādeśaḥ |*
> *tasyāsiddhatvāddu jhalbho herdhiḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, you, such as you are, by ऊत्या (*ūtyā*) (protection) become अवमः (*avamaḥ*) for us, that is, near and close at hand; at the dawning (व्युष्टौ (*vyuṣṭau*), the breaking) of this dawn, in the morning, for the accomplishment of rites such as the Agnihotra, be नेदिष्ठः (*nediṣṭhaḥ*), that is, be exceedingly close to us." Or else: "by coming (गमनेन (*gamanena*)) be our protector." Further: "वरुणं (*varuṇaṃ*) — the disease caused by Varuṇa, such as dropsy, or the sin that covers us — अव यक्ष्व (*ava yakṣva*), that is, अवयज (*avayaja*), destroy it." रराणः (*rarāṇaḥ*) means delighting in the oblation given by us. Or else: "you who bestow on the sacrificers the fruit they most desire, मृळीकं (*mṛḷīkaṃ*) …" (the sentence continues on the next page).

"… this pleasing (*sukhakaraṃ*) oblation, वीहि (*vīhi*), that is, eat. Further, be सुहवः (*suhavaḥ*), one who has a good invocation, for us: ऐधि (*aidhi*), that is, be." The rest of the block gives the grammar of नेदिष्टः (*nediṣṭaḥ*), रराणः (*rarāṇaḥ*) and एधि (*edhi*), which is given in the Grammar section.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- सः त्वं (*saḥ tvaṃ*)—you, so famed
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- ऊती (*ūtī*)—with your protection
- अवमः (*avamaḥ*)—being by our side
- अस्याः उषसः (*asyāḥ uṣasaḥ*)—of this dawn
- व्युष्टौ (*vyuṣṭau*)—at the time of its manifestation
- नेदिष्टः भव (*nediṣṭaḥ bhava*)—grant us your presence
- नः (*naḥ*)—from us
- वरुणं (*varuṇaṃ*)—the diseases caused by Varuṇa
- अव यक्ष्वा (*ava yakṣvā*)—destroy
- रराणः (*rarāṇaḥ*)—enjoying the oblations
- मृळीकं (*mṛḷīkaṃ*)—this pleasing oblation
- वीहि (*vīhi*)—eat
- नः (*naḥ*)—for us
- सुहवः (*suhavaḥ*)—having an excellent invocation
- एधि (*edhi*)—be

Gist

O Agni, you, so famed, be by our side with your protection and grant us your presence at the time of this dawn's manifestation. Destroy the diseases caused by Varuṇa, away from us. Delight in eating this pleasing oblation. Be one who has an excellent invocation for us.

English translation

Agni, our preserver, be most nigh to us with your protection at the breaking of this dawn : deprecate V$_4$runa for us, and, propitiated (by our praise). feed upon the grateful (oblation), and be to us of auspicious invoca- tion.

Special Topics

नः वरुणं अवयुक्ष—अस्माकं वरुणाकृतं जलोदरादिरोगान् अवरकं पापं वा विनाशयेत्यर्थः । (*naḥ varuṇaṃ avayukṣa—asmākaṃ varuṇākṛtaṃ jalodarādirogān avarakaṃ pāpaṃ vā vināśayetyarthaḥ |*) Here "connected with Varuṇa" means: destroy

the great diseases such as dropsy that may arise from the anger of the god Varuṇa, or the many kinds of sin that envelop us; thus Agni is prayed to. Here jalodara (dropsy) is a kind of great disease in which the body fills with water and swells. Because it is connected with water, and because Varuṇa is famed as lord of the waters, it is believed that this kind of disease comes through Varuṇa's pressure. Or again, the fear of water, that is, death by drowning, may likewise come from Varuṇa (continued on the next page).

Such fears are to be removed and the sins destroyed: so the prayer is made.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्य श्रेष्ठा॑ सु॒भग॑स्य सं॒दृग्दे॒वस्य॑ चि॒त्रत॑मा॒ मर्त्ये॑षु ।
शुचि॑ घृ॒तं न त॒प्तम॒घ्न्या॑याः स्पा॒र्हा दे॒वस्य॑ मं॒हने॑व धे॒नोः ॥ ६ ॥

> *asya śreṣṭhā subhagasya saṃdṛgdevasya citratamā martyeṣu |*
> *śuci ghṛtaṃ na taptamaghnyāyāḥ spārhā devasya maṃhaneva dhenoḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्य । श्रेष्ठा । सुभगस्य । संदृक् । देवस्य । चित्रतमा । मर्त्येषु ।
> शुचि । धृतं । नृ । तप्तं । अघ्न्यायाः । स्पार्हा । देवस्य । मंहनाइव । धेनोः ॥

> *asya | śreṣṭhā | subhagasya | saṃdṛk | devasya | citratamā | martyeṣu |*
> *śuci | dhṛtaṃ | nṛ | taptaṃ | aghnyāyāḥ | spārhā | devasya | maṃhanāiva | dhenoḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सुभगस्य सुधनस्य सुष्टु भजनीयस्याग्नेर्देवस्य श्रेष्ठातिशयेन प्रशस्या
> संदृक् संदृष्टिर्मर्त्येषु चित्रतमातिशयेन चायनीया पूजनिया भवति । स्मार्हा
> सर्वैः स्पृहणीया भवति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । यथा देवस्य क्षीरं कामयमानस्य
> पुरुषस्याघ्न्याया गोः शुचि तेजोयुक्तं घृतं क्षरणयुक्तं सप्तं क्षीरं
> स्पृहणीयं भवति । तत्रैव दृष्टांतांतरं । यथा गां भिक्षमाणस्य मर्त्यस्य धेनोर्दोग्धा र्य गोर्मंहनेव ।
> मंहतिर्दानकर्मा । दानं यथा प्रियकरं भवति
> तद्वत् ॥ सुभगस्य । आद्युदात्तं द्व्यच्छंदसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । स्मार्हा । कर्षात्वतो
> घञतोंत उदात्तः । देवस्य । दीव्यतीति देवः । दीव्यतेः कांत्यर्थस्य
> पचाद्यचि रूपं ॥

> *subhagasya sudhanasya suṣṭu bhajanīyasyāgnerdevasya śreṣṭhātiśayena praśasyā*
> *saṃdṛk saṃdṛṣṭirmartyeṣu citratamātiśayena cāyanīyā pūjaniyā bhavati | smārhā*
> *sarvaiḥ spṛhaṇīyā bhavati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | yathā devasya kṣīraṃ kāmayamānasya*
> *puruṣasyāghnyāyā goḥ śuci tejoyuktaṃ ghṛtaṃ kṣaraṇayuktaṃ saptaṃ kṣīraṃ*
> *spṛhaṇīyaṃ bhavati | tatraiva dṛṣṭāṃtāṃtaraṃ | yathā gāṃ bhikṣamāṇasya martyasya dhenordogdhā rya gormaṃhaneva |*
> *maṃhatirdānakarmā | dānaṃ yathā priyakaraṃ bhavati*
> *tadvat ‖ subhagasya | ādyudāttaṃ dvyacchaṃdasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | smārhā | karṣātvato*
> *ghañatoṃta udāttaḥ | devasya | dīvyatīti devaḥ | dīvyateḥ kāṃtyarthasya*
> *pacādyaci rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

Of the god Agni, सुभगस्य (*subhagasya*) — of good wealth, one who is to be well resorted to — the संदृक् (*saṃdṛk*) (sight, glance) is श्रेष्ठा (*śreṣṭhā*), exceedingly praiseworthy; among mortals it is चित्रतमा (*citratamā*), most to be honoured and worshipped, and it is स्पार्हा (*spārhā*), to be desired by all. An illustration follows. As, for a man who desires milk, the शुचि (*śuci*) (bright, full of splendour) घृतं (*ghṛtaṃ*), the heated (सप्तं (*saptaṃ*)) milk of the अघ्न्या (*aghnyā*) cow that flows forth, is desirable;[?345] so too the sight is desired. There is a second illustration: as, for a mortal begging for a cow, the मंहना (*maṃhanā*) of a milch cow — मंहति (*maṃhati*) is a root meaning giving —[?346] that is, as a gift is pleasing, so is it. The rest gives accent and derivation of सुभगस्य (*subhagasya*), स्मार्हा (*smārhā*) and देवस्य (*devasya*) (Grammar section).

Word-to-word meaning

- देवस्य (*devasya*)—for a man who desires milk
- अघ्न्यायाः (*aghnyāyāḥ*)—of the cow
- शुचि (*śuci*)—bright
- धृतं (*dhṛtaṃ*)—well prepared
- तप्तं न (*taptaṃ na*)—as the milk is beneficial (and)
- धेनोः (*dhenoḥ*)—of the milch cow
- मंहनेव (*maṃhaneva*)—as the gift is beneficial
- सुभगस्य (*subhagasya*)—of one who is worshipful[?347]
- अस्य देवस्य (*asya devasya*)—of this Agni, the divine being
- श्रेष्ठा (*śreṣṭhā*)—praiseworthy
- संदृक् (*saṃdṛk*)—the sight
- मर्त्येषु (*martyeṣu*)—among men
- चित्रतमा (*citratamā*)—worthy of worship
- स्पार्हा (*spārhā*)—respected

Gist

As, for a man who desires milk, the bright and well prepared milk of the cow is beneficial, and as the gift of a milch cow is beneficial, so the praiseworthy sight of Agni, who is worshipful and the divine being, is worthy of worship among men and respected.[?348]

English translation

The glance of this auspicious deity, directed towards men, is most excellent, most wonderful, acceptable (to all), as the pure warm butter (from the milk) of the cow (is acceptable) to the deity ; as the gift of a milch-cow (is to a man).

Special Topics

देवस्य अस्य अग्नेः ता परमा सत्या त्रिः जनिमानि स्पार्हा संति (*devasya asya agneḥ tā paramā satyā triḥ janimāni spārhā saṃti*) — It is said here that the three famed and true births, or forms of origin, of this Agni, the divine or resplendent one, are most attractive. The commentator cites the Ṛks

त्रीणि जाना परि भूषंत्यस्य समुद्र एकं दिव्येकमप्पु । (*trīṇi jānā pari bhūṣaṃtyasya samudra ekaṃ divyekamappu |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-95-3)

दिवस्परि प्रथमं जज्ञे अग्निरस्मद्वितीयं परि जावेदाः । (ऋ. सं. १०-४५-१) ऎंब ऋक्कुगळन्नु दाहरिसि अग्निय मूरुविधवाद स्वरूपगळन्नु विवरिसिद्दारॆ. ऎंदरॆ अग्निगॆ मूरु रूपगळिवॆ. समुद्रदल्लि बाडबानलरूपदिंदलू अंतरिक्षदल्लि वैद्युताग्निरूपदिंदलू (मिंचिनरूप) स्वर्गदल्लि आदित्यरूपदिंदलू अग्नियु इरुवनॆंदु ई ऋक्कुगळल्लियू हेळिदॆ. इदल्लदे अग्निगॆ पवमान, वनस्पति, शुचि ऎंब मूरु विधरूपगळु, पवमान, शुचि, पावक ऎंदू अथवा अग्नि, वैश्वानर, जातवेदाः (*divaspari prathamaṃ jajñe agnirasmadvitīyaṃ pari jāvedāḥ | (ṛ. saṃ. 10-45-1) èṃba ṛkkugaḷannu dāharisi agniya mūruvidhavāda svarūpagaḷannu vivarisiddārè. èṃdarè agnigè mūru rūpagaḷivè. samudradalli bāḍabānalarūpadiṃdalū aṃtarikṣadalli vaidyutāgnirūpadiṃdalū (miṃcinarūpa) svargadalli ādityarūpadiṃdalū agniyu iruvanèṃdu ī ṛkkugaḷalliyū heḷidè. idalladè agnigè pavamāna, vanaspati, śuci èṃba mūru vidharūpagaḷu, pavamāna, śuci, pāvaka èṃdū athavā agni, vaiśvānara, jātavedāḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-45-1)

and explains the threefold forms of Agni. That is, Agni has three forms: these Ṛks too say that Agni exists in the sea as the submarine fire, in the atmosphere as lightning fire (the form of lightning), and in heaven as the sun. Besides this, it is well known that Agni has three forms called Pavamāna, Vanaspati and Śuci; or three forms called Pavamāna, Śuci and Pāvaka; or Agni, Vaiśvānara and Jātavedas. For a detailed explanation of this subject see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 8, pp. 17-19.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रिर॑स्य॒ ता प॑र॒मा स॑न्ति स॒त्या स्पा॒र्हा दे॒वस्य॒ जनि॑मान्य॒ग्नेः ।
अ॒न॒न्ते अ॒न्तः परि॑वीत॒ आगा॒च्छुचि॑ः शु॒क्रो अ॒र्यो रोरु॑चानः ॥ ७ ॥

> *trirasya tā paramā santi satyā spārhā devasya janimānyagneḥ |*
> *anante antaḥ parivīta āgācchuciḥ śukro aryo rorucānaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्रिः । अस्य । ता । परमा । संति । सत्या । स्वार्हा । देवस्य । जनिमानि । अग्नेः ।
> अनंते । अंतरिति । परिऽवीतः । आ । अगात् । शुचिः । शुक्रः । अर्यः । रोरुचानः ॥७॥

> *triḥ | asya | tā | paramā | saṃti | satyā | svārhā | devasya | janimāni | agneḥ |*
> *anaṃte | aṃtariti | pari 'vītaḥ | ā | agāt | śuciḥ | śukraḥ | aryaḥ | rorucānaḥ ‖7‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्नेरग्न्यभिमानिनोऽस्य देवस्य त्रिस्त्रीण्यग्निवायुसूर्यात्मना त्रीणि ता तानि प्रसिद्धानि परमोत्तमानि सत्या यथार्थभूतानि जनिमानि जन्मानि स्वाहर्णा सर्वैः स्पृहणीयानि संति । यद्वा । अग्नेरेव त्रीणि जन्मानि दिवस्परि प्रथमं जज्ञे अग्निः । ऋग्वे. १०–४५–१ । इति त्रीणि जाना परि भूषंत्यस्य । ऋग्वे. १–९५–३ । इत्येवमादिषु मंत्रेषु प्रसिद्धानि । अनंतेऽपर्यंते नभस्यंतर्मध्ये स्वतेजसा परिवीतः परिवेष्टितः शुचिः सर्वस्य शोधकः शुक्रो दीप्तियुक्तोऽत एव रोरुचानो भृशं दीप्यमानोऽर्यः स्वामि तादृशो देव आगात् । अस्मदीयं यज्ञं प्रत्यागच्छतु ॥ सत्या । शेश्छंदसि बहुलमिति शेर्लुक् । परिवीतः । व्येञ् संवरणे । कर्मणि क्तः । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः प्रकृतिस्वरत्वं । अर्यः । ऋ गतौ । अर्यः स्वामिवैश्ययोरिति यत्पत्ययांतो निपातितः । स्वामिन्यंतोदात्तत्वं वक्तव्यमित्यंतोदात्तत्वं ॥

> *agneragnyabhimānino 'sya devasya tristrīṇyagnivāyusūryātmanā trīṇi tā tāni*
> *prasiddhāni paramottamāni satyā yathārthabhūtāni janimāni janmāni*
> *svāharṇā sarvaiḥ spṛhaṇīyāni saṃti | yadvā | agnereva trīṇi janmāni*
> *divaspari prathamaṃ jajñe agniḥ | ṛgve.*
> *10-45-1 | iti trīṇi jānā pari bhūṣaṃtyasya | ṛgve. 1-95-3 | ityevamādiṣu maṃtreṣu*
> *prasiddhāni | anaṃte 'paryaṃte nabhasyaṃtarmadhyè svatejasā parivītaḥ pariveṣṭitaḥ śuciḥ*
> *sarvasya śodhakaḥ śukro dīptiyukto 'ta eva rorucāno bhṛśaṃ dīpyamāno 'ryaḥ*
> *svāmiā tādṛśo deva āgāt | asmadīyaṃ yajñaṃ pratyāgacchatu ‖ satyā | śeśbaṃdasi*
> *bahulamiti śerluk | parivītaḥ | vyeñ saṃvaraṇe | karmaṇi ktaḥ |*
> *yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ prakṛtisvaratvaṃ |*
> *aryaḥ | ṛ gatau | aryaḥ svāmivaiśyayoriti yatpatyayāṃto nipātitaḥ |*
> *svāminyaṃtodāttatvaṃ vaktavyamityaṃtodāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Of this divine Agni, who presides over fire, the three — as fire, wind and sun — the famed, supreme, true (that is, real) births (जनिमानि (*janimāni*), जन्मानि (*janmāni*)) are desirable to all. Or else: Agni's own three births are famed in mantras such as दिवस्परि प्रथमं जज्ञे अग्निः (*divaspari prathamaṃ jajñe agniḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-45-1) and त्रीणि जाना परि भूषंत्यस्य (*trīṇi jānā pari bhūṣaṃtyasya*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-95-3). In the endless sky, in the middle, enveloped (परिवीतः (*parivītaḥ*)) by his own radiance, शुचिः (*śuciḥ*) (the purifier of all), शुक्रः (*śukraḥ*) (full of brightness), and therefore रोरुचानः (*rorucānaḥ*) (shining intensely), the अर्यः (*aryaḥ*) (lord), such a god, आगात् (*āgāt*): may he come to our sacrifice. The rest gives the grammar of सत्या (*satyā*), परिवीतः (*parivītaḥ*) and अर्यः (*aryaḥ*) (Grammar section).

Word-to-word meaning

- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of the divine being
- अस्य अग्नेः (*asya agneḥ*)—of this Agni
- ता (*tā*)—famed

- परमा (*paramā*)—supreme
- सत्या (*satyā*)—true in nature
- त्रिः जनिमानि (*triḥ janimāni*)—the three forms of origin also
- स्पार्हा संति (*spārhā saṃti*)—are most attractive
- अनंते (*anaṃte*)—of the boundless atmosphere
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the middle
- परिवीतः (*parivītaḥ*)—enveloped by his own radiance
- शुचिः (*śuciḥ*)—the purifier
- शुक्रः (*śukraḥ*)—endowed with brightness
- रोरुचानः (*rorucānaḥ*)—shining intensely
- अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)—the lord, Agni
- आगात् (*āgāt*)—may he come graciously to our sacrifice

Gist

The famed, supreme and true three forms of origin (as fire, wind and sun) of this Agni, the divine being, are also most attractive. In the middle of the unfathomable

atmosphere, enveloped by his own radiance, the purifier, endowed with brightness, shining intensely, the lord, Agni — may he come graciously to our sacrifice.

English translation

These are the supreme, true, and desirable births of this divine Agni, invested (with radiance) in the unbounded (firmament): pure, bright, radiant lord (of all), may he come (to our) sacrifice.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स दू॒तो विश्वेद॒भि व॑ष्टि॒ सद्मा॒ होता॒ हिर॑ण्यरथो॒ रं
सु॑जिह्वः ।
रो॒हिद॑श्वो वपु॒ष्यो॑ वि॒भावा॒ सदा॑ र॒ण्वः पि॑तु॒मती॑व सं॒
सत् ॥ ८ ॥

> *sa dūto viśvedabhi vaṣṭi sadmā hotā hiraṇyaratho raṃsujihvaḥ |*
> *rohidaśvo vapuṣyo vibhāvā sadā raṇvaḥ pitumatīva saṃsat ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । दूतः । विश्वा । इत् । अभि । वष्टि । सद्म । होता । हिरण्यरथः । रंसुजिह्वः ।
> रोहित्स्य अश्वः । वपुष्यः । विभावा । सदा । रण्वः । पितुमतीइव । संसत् ॥ ८ ॥

> *saḥ | dūtaḥ | viśvā | it | abhi | vaṣṭi | sadma | hotā | hiraṇyarathaḥ |*
> *raṃsujihvaḥ |*
> *rohitsya aśvaḥ | vapuṣyaḥ | vibhāvā | sadā | raṇvaḥ | pitumatīiva |*
> *saṃsat ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवानां दूतो होता देवानामाह्वाता हिरण्यरथः सुवर्णमयरथोपेतो रंसुजिह्वो
> रमणीयशोभनज्वालोपेतः स तादृशोग्निर्विश्वेत् सर्वाण्वेव सद्म देवयजनस्थानान्यभि वष्टि ।
> कामयते । पुनश्च कीदृशः । रोहिदश्वः ।
> रोहितवर्णा अश्वा यस्य स तथोक्तः । वपुष्यो वपुषि रूपे साधुर्विभावा कांतियुक्तोऽत एव सदा
> रणो रमणीयो भवति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । पितुमतीव संसत् ।
> यथान्नादिवत्समृद्धं गृहं रमणीयं तद्वत् ॥ रंसुजिह्वः । रमतेरन्येभ्योऽपि
> दृश्यंत इति विच् । बहुव्रिह पूर्वपदस्वरः । वपुष्यः । तत्र साधुरिति यत् । तित्स्वरितः।
> विभावा । छंदसीवनिपाविति वनिप् ॥

> *devānāṃ dūto hotā devānāmāhvātā hiraṇyarathaḥ*
> *suvarṇamayarathopeto raṃsujihvò ramaṇīyaśobhanajvālopetaḥ sa*
> *tādṛśognirviśvet sarvāṇveva sadma devayajanasthānānyabhi vaṣṭi |*
> *kāmayate | punaśca kīdṛśaḥ | rohidaśvaḥ |*

> *rohitavarṇā aśvā yasya sa tathoktaḥ | vapuṣyo vapuṣi rūpe sādhurvibhāvā kāṃtiyukto 'ta eva sadā raṇo ramaṇīyo bhavati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | pitumatīva saṃsat |*
> *yathānnādivatsamṛddhaṃ gṛhaṃ ramaṇīyaṃ tadvat ‖ raṃsujihvaḥ | ramateranyebhyo 'pi*
> *dṛśyaṃta iti vic | bahuvriha pūrvapadasvaraḥ | vapuṣyaḥ | tatra sādhuriti yat | titsvaritaḥ|*
> *vibhāvā | chaṃdasīvanipāviti vanip ‖*

Summary

Agni is the messenger of the gods, the होता (*hotā*) (the caller of the gods), हिरण्यरथः (*hiraṇyarathaḥ*) (possessed of a golden chariot), रंसुजिह्वः (*raṃsujihvaḥ*) (possessed of lovely, beautiful flames). Such an Agni विश्वेत् (*viśvet*), all the सद्म (*sadma*) (the places of the gods' sacrifice), अभि वष्टि (*abhi vaṣṭi*), desires. And of what kind is he further? रोहिदश्वः (*rohidaśvaḥ*): he whose horses are red. वपुष्यः (*vapuṣyaḥ*): excellent in form; विभावा (*vibhāvā*): full of radiance, and therefore he is always रण्वः (*raṇvaḥ*), delightful. The illustration: पितुमतीव संसत् (*pitumatīva saṃsat*) — as a house abundant in food and the like is delightful, so is he. The rest gives the grammar of रंसुजिह्वः (*raṃsujihvaḥ*), वपुष्यः (*vapuṣyaḥ*) and विभावा (*vibhāvā*) (Grammar section).

Word-to-word meaning

- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—the messenger of the gods
- होता (*hotā*)—the one who calls the gods
- हिरण्यरथः (*hiraṇyarathaḥ*)—one who has a golden chariot
- रंसुजिह्वः (*raṃsujihvaḥ*)—one who has lovely flames
- सः (*saḥ*)—the famed

Gist

Agni, the messenger of the gods, who calls the gods to the sacrifice, who has a golden chariot, whose flames are lovely, the renowned one, desires all the sacrificial houses. As a house supplied with food is pleasing, so Agni, whose horses are golden-hued, who has an attractive form, who is resplendent, is always one who gives pleasure.

English translation

The messenger, the invoker (of the gods), riding in a golden chariot with a tongue of flame, he frequents all the chambers (of sacrifice); drawn by red horses, embodied, resplendent, always agreeable, as a dwelling well supplied with food.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स चे॑तय॒न्मनु॑षो य॒ज्ञब॑न्धु॒ः प्र तं म॒ह्या र॑श॒नया॑ नयन्ति ।
स क्षे॑त्यस्य॒ दुर्या॑सु॒ साध॑न्दे॒वो मर्त॑स्य सधनि॒त्वमा॑प ॥ ९ ॥

> *sa cetayanmanuṣo yajñabandhuḥ pra taṃ mahyā raśanayā nayanti |*
> *sa kṣetyasya duryāsu sādhandevo martasya sadhanitvamāpa ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । चेतयत् । मनुषः । यज्ञबंधुः । प्र । तम् । मह्या । रशनया । नयंति ।
> सः । क्षेति । अस्य । दुर्यासु । साधन् । देवः । मर्तस्य । सधनित्वं । आप ॥ ९ ॥

> *saḥ | cetayat | manuṣaḥ | yajñabaṃdhuḥ | pra | tam | mahyā | raśanayā | nayaṃti |*
> *saḥ | kṣeti | asya | duryāsu | sādhan | devaḥ | martasya | sadhanitvaṃ | āpa ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यज्ञ बंधुः । यज्ञेऽग्निहोत्रादौ बंधनं विनियोचनं यस्य स तथोक्तः ।
> कोऽग्निर्मनुषः कर्मणि प्रवृत्तान्मनुष्यान् चेतयत् । जानाति । मह्या महत्या

> *yajña baṃdhuḥ | yajñe 'gnihotrādau baṃdhanaṃ viniyocanaṃ yasya sa tathoktaḥ |*
> *ko 'gnirmanuṣaḥ karmaṇi pravṛttānmanuṣyān cetayat | jānāti | mahyā mahatyā*

> रशनया स्तुतिरूपया रज्ज्ञा युक्तं तं तादृशमग्निं प्रणयंति । उत्तरवेद्यादिष्टध्वर्य्यादयः प्रक्षिपंति । मर्तस्य मनुष्यस्यास्य यजमानस्य दुर्यासु गृहेषु
> साधन् अभीष्टानि साधयन् सोऽग्निः क्षेति । वसति । स देवो द्योतमानोऽग्निः
> सधनित्वं यस्य गृहे निवसति तेन धनिना साहित्यमाप । प्राप्नोति । प्रभूतं धनं
> यजमानाय दापयित्वा तेन सहितोऽभवदित्यर्थः ॥ साधन् । राध साध संसिद्धौ ।
> ण्यंतस्य शतरि रूपं ॥

> *raśanayā stutirūpayā rajjñā yuktaṃ taṃ tādṛśamagniṃ praṇayaṃti | uttaravedyādiṣṭadhvaryyādayaḥ prakṣipaṃti | martasya manuṣyasyāsya yajamānasya duryāsu gṛheṣu*
> *sādhan abhīṣṭāni sādhayan so 'gniḥ kṣeti | vasati | sa devo dyotamāno 'gniḥ*
> *sadhanitvaṃ yasya gṛhe nivasati tena dhaninā sāhityamāpa | prāpnoti | prabhūtaṃ dhanaṃ*
> *yajamānāya dāpayitvā tena sahito 'bhavadityarthaḥ ‖ sādhan | rādha sādha saṃsiddhau |*
> *ṇyaṃtasya śatari rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

यज्ञ बंधुः (*yajña baṃdhuḥ*): one whose binding, that is, employment, is in the sacrifice, in the Agnihotra and the like. Agni "knows" (चेतयत् (*cetayat*)) the men engaged in rites. मह्या (*mahyā*) means "by the great" (cord)...

...रशनया (*raśanayā*): Agni, joined to such a cord, in the form of praise, is led forward; the Adhvaryu and others place him on the Uttaravedi and so on. In the houses (दुर्यासु (*duryāsu*)) of this mortal, the sacrificer, accomplishing his desires, Agni dwells. That shining god obtains सधनित्वं (*sadhanitvaṃ*), fellowship with the wealthy man in whose house he lives; the meaning is that he has a great wealth given to the sacrificer and becomes associated with it. Grammar of साधन् (*sādhan*) is given in the commentary.

Word-to-word meaning

- यज्ञबंधुः (*yajñabaṃdhuḥ*)—kinsman of the sacrifice
- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)—men engaged in rites

- चेतयत् (*cetayat*)—knows
- मह्या (*mahyā*)—great
- रशनया (*raśanayā*)—with a cord that is of the nature of praise
- तं (*taṃ*)—that Agni
- प्र नयंति (*pra nayaṃti*)—the Adhvaryus establish
- मर्तस्य (*martasya*)—of the mortal
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this sacrificer
- दुर्यासु (*duryāsu*)—in the houses
- साधन् (*sādhan*)—accomplishing his desires
- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- क्षेति (*kṣeti*)—dwells
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—the shining Agni
- सधीनत्वं (*sadhīnatvaṃ*)—union with the wealthy sacrificer
- आप (*āpa*)—obtains

Gist

Agni, the kinsman of the sacrifice, comes to know the devotion of men engaged in the rite. The Adhvaryus establish that Agni, joined to the great cord that is of the nature of praise. In the houses of this mortal sacrificer Agni dwells, accomplishing his desires. The shining Agni, united with the wealthy sacrificer, accomplishes his welfare.

English translation

Associated with sacrifice, and knowing those men (who are engaged in good works), they lead him with the strong cord (of praise): he the divine Agni, fulfilling (all desires), abides in the dwelling of this mortal, and obtains fellowship in his wealth.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स तू नो॑ अ॒ग्निर्न॑यतु प्र॒जा॒नन्न॒च्छा॒ रत्नं॑ दे॒वभ॑क्तं॒ य
द॑स्य ।
धि॒या य॒द्विश्वे॑ अ॒मृता॒ अकृ॑ण्व॒न्द्यौष्पि॒ता ज॑नि॒ता स॒त्य
मु॑क्षन् ॥ १० ॥

> *sa tū no agnirnayatu prajānannacchā ratnaṃ devabhaktaṃ yadasya |*
> *dhiyā yadviśve amṛtā akṛṇvandyauṣpitā janitā satyamukṣan ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । तु । नः । अग्निः । नयतु । प्रजानन् । अच्छ । रत्नं । देवभक्तं । यत् । अस्य ।
> धिया । यत् । विश्वे । अमृताः । अकृण्वन् । द्यौः । पिता । जनिता । सत्यं । उक्षन् ॥१०॥

> *saḥ | tu | naḥ | agniḥ | nayatu | prajānan | accha | ratnaṃ | devabhaktaṃ | yat | asya |*
> *dhiyā | yat | viśve | amṛtāḥ | akṛṇvan | dyauḥ | pitā | janitā | satyaṃ | ukṣan ‖10‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रजानन् सर्वं जानानः सोग्निर्देवभक्तं देवैर्देवनशीलैः स्तोतृभिः संभजनीयमस्वाग्नेः संबंधि यदुत्तमं रत्नं धनमस्ति तद्रत्नमच्छाभिमुख्येन तु
> क्षिप्रं नोऽस्मान्नयतु । प्रापयतु । अमृता मरणधर्मरहिता विश्वे सर्वे देवा
> धिया हविर्वहनलक्षणेन कर्मणा हेतुना यद्यमग्निमकृण्वन् हविषां प्रापयितारमकुर्वन् । यस्य चाग्नेर्दौः पिता पालयत्री जनिता जनयित्रि च । अग्ने दिवः
> सूनुरसि प्रचेताः । ऋग्वे. ३–२५–१ । इति श्रवणात् । यद्वा । द्यार्देवनशील आदित्यः पिता जनयिता च आदित्यादग्निरित्याम्नानात् । सत्यं यथार्थभूतं तमग्निमुक्सन् । घृताद्याहुतिभिरध्वय्र्वादयः सिंचंति ॥ देवभक्तं । भज सेवायां । कर्मणि क्तः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । उक्षन् । उक्ष सेचने । लजि रूपं । बहुलं छंदसीत्यडभावः ॥

> *prajānan sarvaṃ jānānaḥ sognirdevabhaktaṃ devairdevanaśīlaiḥ*
> *stotṛbhiḥ saṃbhajanīyamasvāgneḥ saṃbaṃdhi yaduttamaṃ ratnaṃ*
> *dhanamasti tadratnamacchābhimukhyena tu*
> *kṣipraṃ no 'smānnayatu | prāpayatu | amṛtā maraṇadharmarahitā*
> *viśve sarvè devā*
> *dhiyā havirvahanalakṣaṇena karmaṇā hetunā yadyamagnimakṛṇvan*
> *haviṣāṃ prāpayitāramakurvan | yasya cāgnerdauḥ pitā pālayatrī janitā*
> *janayitri ca | agne divaḥ*
> *sūnurasi pracetāḥ | ṛgve. 3-25-1 | iti śravaṇāt | yadvā | dyārdevanaśīla*
> *ādityaḥ*
> *pitā janayitā ca ādityādagnirityāmnānāt | satyaṃ yathārthabhūtaṃ*
> *tamagnimuksan |*
> *ghṛtādyāhutibhiradhvaydādayaḥ siṃcaṃti ‖ devabhaktaṃ | bhaja*
> *sevāyāṃ | karmaṇi ktaḥ |*
> *tṛtīyā karmaṇīti pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | ukṣan | ukṣa secane | laji*
> *rūpaṃ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyaḍabhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

Agni, who knows all, is asked to bring to us quickly, face to face, the best treasure, wealth, that belongs to him and is to be shared by the gods, the shining praisers. The immortal gods, all of them, by the rite of carrying oblations made him the conveyor of oblations; and heaven is his father, protector, and his mother, begetter, as is heard in अग्ने दिवः सूनुरसि प्रचेताः । (*agne divaḥ sūnurasi pracetāḥ* |) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-25-1). Or else: Dyu, the shining Āditya, is father and begetter, since tradition says Agni is from Āditya. सत्यं (*satyaṃ*) is the real Agni; the Adhvaryus and others sprinkle him with oblations such as ghee. Grammar of देवभक्तं (*devabhaktaṃ*) and उक्षन् (*ukṣan*) follows.

Word-to-word meaning

- प्रजानन् (*prajānan*)—knowing all
- सः अग्निः (*saḥ agniḥ*)—Agni
- देवभक्तं (*devabhaktaṃ*)—worthy of worship by the praisers
- अस्य (*asya*)—belonging to him
- यत् रत्नं (*yat ratnaṃ*)—whatever wealth there is, that

- तु (*tu*)—quickly
- नः अच्छ (*naḥ accha*)—to us, face to face
- नयतु (*nayatu*)—let him bring
- अमृताः (*amṛtāḥ*)—free from mortality
- विश्वे (*viśve*)—all the gods
- धिया (*dhiyā*)—by the rite of carrying oblations to them
- यत् (*yat*)—whom
- अकृण्वन् (*akṛṇvan*)—they made the divine messenger
- यस्य (*yasya*)—whose
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)—heaven
- पिता (*pitā*)—as protector
- जनिता (*janitā*)—as begetter
- सत्यं (*satyaṃ*)—that Agni, true in nature
- उक्षन् (*ukṣan*)—(the Adhvaryus) sprinkle with ghee and the like

Gist

May Agni, the all-knowing, quickly bring us the wealth that is worthy of worship by all praisers. The Adhvaryus sprinkle with ghee and the like that Agni, true in nature, whom all the immortal gods, by the rite of carrying their oblations, made their messenger, and whose begetter and protector is heaven.

English translation

May that wise Agni conduct us to that wealth which is desired by the devout ; he whom all the immortals have created for (the performance of) sacred rites ; of whom heaven is the parent and progenitor, and whom (the priests) verily sprinkle (with oblations).

Special Topics

यस्य द्यौः पिता जनिता (*yasya dyauḥ pitā janitā*)—Here it is said that heaven is father and protector of Agni: अग्ने दिवः सूनुरसि प्रचेतास्तना पृथिव्या उत विश्ववेदाः (*agne divaḥ sūnurasi pracetāstanā pṛthivyā uta viśvavedāḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-25-1). "O Agni, you are known as all-knowing, one who knows everything; you are the son of heaven (or of the deity presiding over heaven) and of the earth": thus the seer Viśvāmitra praised Agni. Moreover, in many places it is said that heaven and earth are the parents of all the other gods, Agni and the rest.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स जा॑यत प्रथ॒मः प॒स्त्या॑सु म॒हो बु॒ध्ने रज॑सो अ॒स्य योनौ॑ ।
अ॒पाद॑शी॒र्षा गु॒हमा॑नो॒ अन्ता॒योयु॑वानो वृष॒भस्य॑ नी॒ळे
॥ ११ ॥

> *sa jāyata prathamaḥ pastyāsu maho budhne rajaso asya yonau |*
> *apādaśīrṣā guhamāno antāyoyuvāno vṛṣabhasya nīḷe ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स । जायत । प्रथमः । पस्ता सु । महः । बुद्धे । रजसः । अस्य । योन् ।
> अपात् । अशीर्षा । गुहमानः । अंता । आयोयुवानः । वृषभस्य । नीळे ॥ ११ ॥

> *sa | jāyata | prathamaḥ | pastā su | mahaḥ | buddhe | rajasaḥ | asya | yon |*
> *apāt | aśīrṣā | guhamānaḥ | aṃtā | āyoyuvānaḥ | vṛṣabhasya | nīḷe ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोऽग्निः प्रथम आहवनीयादिरूपतया श्रेष्ठः सन् पस्त्यासु यजमानानां गृहेषु जायत । आहुत्यधिकरणतया संपद्यते । तथा महो महतोऽस्य रजसोऽंतरिक्षस्य बुध्ने मूले पृथिव्यां तत्रापि योनावुत्तरवेद्यादिस्थाने संपद्यते ।
> सोऽग्निरपात्पादवर्जितोऽशीर्षा शिरोवर्जितः । तदेवाह ॥ अंताद्यंते पादशिरसी गुहमानो गूहमानः । अविज्ञेयपादशिरा इत्यर्थः । वृषभस्य वर्षणसमर्थस्य मेघस्य नीळे निलये नभस्यायोयुवानो धूमाकारेणात्मानमयोजयन्वर्तते
> यद्वा । यः प्रथमो वैद्युतोऽग्निः पस्त्यादिषु नदीषु बुध्नेऽंतरिक्षे महो महतो रजस उदकस्य तेजसो वा योन् स्थाने च चरति ! अपादशीर्षा पादशिरोवर्जितोऽंतात्मनः पर्यंतप्रदेशान् स्वतेजसा गुहमान अच्छादयन् पुनश्चायोयुवानस्तानि

> तेजांसि स्वात्मनि मिश्रीकुर्वन्नृषभस्य मेघस्य नीळे स्थाने नभसि
> चरति सोऽग्निरधुना कर्मयोग्यतयाजायत ॥ अपात् । पादस्य लोपोऽहस्ता दिभ्य
> इत्यकारलोपः समासांतः । गुहमानः । गुहू संवरणे । शविकरणी । शानच रूपं ।
> शानचो लसार्वधातुकस्वरे कृते प्रत्ययस्वरः । आयोयुवानः । यु मिश्रणे ।
> यज् लुकि शानचि रूपं । अभ्यस्तस्वरेणाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *so 'gniḥ prathama āhavanīyādirūpatayā śreṣṭhaḥ san pastyāsu yajamānānāṃ*
> *gṛheṣu jāyata | āhutyadhikaraṇatayā saṃpadyate | tathā maho mahato 'sya rajaso 'ṃtarikṣasya budhne mūle pṛthivyāṃ tatrāpi yonāvuttaravedyādisthāne saṃpadyate |*
> *so 'gnirapātpādavarjito 'śīrṣā śirovarjitaḥ | tadevāha ‖ aṃtādyaṃte pādaśirasī*
> *guhamāno gūhamānaḥ | avijñeyapādaśirā ityarthaḥ | vṛṣabhasya varṣaṇasamarthasya*
> *meghasya nīḷe nilaye nabhasyāyoyuvāno dhūmākāreṇātmānamayojayanvartate*
> *yadvā | yaḥ prathamo vaidyuto 'gniḥ pastyādiṣu nadīṣu budhne 'ṃtarikṣe maho*
> *mahato rajasa udakasya tejaso vā yon sthāne ca carati ! apādaśīrṣā*
> *pādaśirovarjito 'ṃtātmanaḥ paryaṃtapradeśān svatejasā guhamāna*
> *acchādayan punaścāyoyuvānastāni tejāṃsi svātmani*
> *miśrīkurvannṛṣabhasya meghasya nīḷe sthāne nabhasi*
> *carati so 'gniradhunā karmayogyatayājāyata ‖ apāt | pādasya lopo 'hastā dibhya*
> *ityakāralopaḥ samāsāṃtaḥ | guhamānaḥ | guhū saṃvaraṇe | śavikaraṇī | śānaca rūpaṃ |*
> *śānaco lasārvadhātukasvare kṛte pratyayasvaraḥ | āyoyuvānaḥ | yu miśraṇe |*
> *yaj luki śānaci rūpaṃ | abhyastasvareṇādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

That Agni, first, being foremost in the form of the Āhavanīya and so on, is born in the houses of the sacrificers, coming into being as the receptacle of oblations. Likewise he comes into being at the base (बुध्ने (*budhne*)) of this great firmament (रजसः (*rajasaḥ*)), on the earth, and there in the place (योनौ (*yonau*)) of the Uttaravedi and so on. He is footless and headless; he says so: अंता (*aṃtā*) are the ends, feet and head, which he hides, so that his feet and head cannot be known. In the dwelling of the rain-cloud (वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*)), able to rain, in the sky, he joins himself in the form of smoke. Or else: the first, the lightning fire, moves in the rivers and the like, at the base in the sky, and in the place of the great water or radiance; footless and headless, concealing with his own radiance the regions up to his extremities and again mingling those radiances in himself, he moves in the sky, the dwelling of the cloud; that Agni is now born fit for the rite. Grammar of अपात् (*apāt*), गुहमानः (*guhamānaḥ*) and आयोयुवानः (*āyoyuvānaḥ*) follows.

Word-to-word meaning

- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- प्रथमः (*prathamaḥ*)—first (in the form of the Āhavanīya and so on)
- पस्त्यासु (*pastyāsu*)—in the houses of the sacrificers
- जायते (*jāyate*)—is born
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—great
- अस्य रजसः (*asya rajasaḥ*)—of the firmament
- बुध्ने (*budhne*)—at the base, of the earth
- योन्सौ (*yonsau*)—in the region of the Uttaravedi (is established)
- अपात् (*apāt*)—footless
- आशीर्षा (*āśīrṣā*)—headless (and)
- अंता (*aṃtā*)—feet and heads at the ends
- गुहमानः (*guhamānaḥ*)—keeping hidden
- वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*)—of the rain-making cloud
- नीळे (*nīḷe*)—in the sky, the dwelling
- आयोयुवानः (*āyoyuvānaḥ*)—is united with smoke

Gist

Agni is first born in the sacrificial houses of the sacrificers, in the form of the Āhavanīya and so on. He is established in the Uttaravedi region of the earth, the base of the great firmament. Footless, headless, keeping hidden his feet and head at the ends, he is united with smoke in the sky, the dwelling of the rain-making cloud.

English translation

He is first engendered in the habitations (of the sacrificers); then upon his stations, (the altar), the base of the vast firmament; without feet, without head, concealing his extremities, combining with smoke in the nest of the rain-cloud.

Special Topics

अपात् अशीर्षा अंता गुहमानः वृषभस्य नीळे आयोयुवानः (*apāt aśīrṣā aṃtā guhamānaḥ vṛṣabhasya nīḷe āyoyuvānaḥ*)—Here it is said that this Agni, without feet and head, or keeping them hidden so that no one sees them, is united in the form of smoke in the circle of the rain-making cloud. What is in the circle of the cloud is the lightning fire (vaidyutāgni, the flash). Only its radiance is visible to all; the other parts of the fire (that is, the feet and heads) are seen by no one. Moreover, even the fire on the earth cannot be divided into parts such as feet and head. Since clouds exist in the form of water vapour, the Agni united in them is likewise present in the form of smoke: such is the meaning.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र शर्ध॑ आर्त प्रथ॒मं विं॑प॒न्याँ ऋ॒तस्य॒ योना॑ वृष॒भ
स्यं॑ नी॒ळे ।
स्पा॒र्हों युवा॑ वपु॒ष्यों॑ वि॒भावा॑ स॒प्त प्रि॒यासों॑ऽजनय
न्त॒ वृष्णें॑ ॥ १२ ॥

> *pra śardha ārta prathamaṃ vipanyā~ ṛtasya yonā vṛṣabhasya nīḷe |*
> *spārho yuvā vapuṣyo vibhāvā sapta priyāso 'janayanta vṛṣṇe ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । शर्धः । आर्त । प्रथमं । विपन्या । ऋतस्य । योना । वृषभस्य । नीळे ।
> स्पार्हः । युवा । वपुष्यः । विभावा । सप्त । प्रियासः । अजनयंत । वृष्णे ॥ १२ ॥

> *pra | śardhaḥ | ārta | prathamaṃ | vipanyā | ṛtasya | yonā |*
> *vṛṣabhasya | nīḷe |*
> *spārhaḥ | yuvā | vapuṣyaḥ | vibhāvā | sapta | priyāsaḥ | ajanayaṃta |*
> *vṛṣṇe ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे आग्ने विपन्या स्तुत्या युक्तमृतस्योदकस्य योन् स्थाने वृषभस्य वर्षणसमर्थस्य मेघस्य
> नीळे कुलायभूतेऽंतरिक्षे वैद्युताग्निरूपेण वर्तमानं त्वां
> शर्धस्तेजः प्रथमं प्रार्त । प्रकर्षेण गच्छति । यश्चाग्निः स्वाहर्ह सर्वैः स्पृहणीयो
> युवा नित्यतरुणो वपुष्यः कमनीयो विभावा दीप्तिमान् तस्मै वृष्णेऽभिमतफलवर्षकायाग्नये
> प्रियासः प्रियाः सप्त होत्रका अजनयंत । स्तोत्रमकुर्वन् ॥
> आर्त । ऋ गतौ । लजि व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । निघातः । विपन्या । पन चेत्यस्येन्प्रत्ययः ।
> कृदिकारादक्तिन इति जीष् । प्रत्ययस्वरेणांतोदात्तः । उदात्तायणो
> हल्पूर्वादिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । विपन्य ऋतस्येत्यत्र संहितायामिकोऽसवर्णे
> शाकल्यस्य ह्रस्वश्च । पा. ६–१–१२७ । इत्यनिकोऽसि ह्रस्पोऽनुनासिकश्च ॥

> *he āgne vipanyā stutyā yuktamṛtasyodakasya yon sthāne vṛṣabhasya*
> *varṣaṇasamarthasya meghasya nīḷe kulāyabhūte 'ṃtarikṣe*
> *vaidyutāgnirūpeṇa vartamānaṃ tvāṃ*
> *śardhastejaḥ prathamaṃ prārta | prakarṣeṇa gacchati | yaścāgniḥ*
> *svāharha sarvèḥ spṛhaṇīyo*
> *yuvā nityataruṇo vapuṣyaḥ kamanīyo vibhāvā dīptimān tasmai vṛṣṇe*
> *'bhimataphalavarṣakāyāgnaye priyāsaḥ priyāḥ sapta hotrakā*
> *ajanayaṃta | stotramakurvan ‖*
> *ārta | ṛ gatau | laji vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | nighātaḥ | vipanyā | pana*
> *cetyasyenpratyayaḥ | kṛdikārādaktina iti jīṣ |*
> *pratyayasvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | udāttāyaṇo*
> *halpūrvāditi vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | vipanya ṛtasyetyatra saṃhitāyāmiko*
> *'savarṇè*
> *śākalyasya hrasvaśca | pā. 6-1-127 | ityaniko 'si hraspo 'nunāsikaśca ‖*

Summary

O Agni, radiance first proceeds to you. You are accompanied by praise (विपन्या (*vipanyā*)) and abide in the form of lightning-fire in the sky. That sky is the place (योनि (*yoni*)) of water and the nest of the rain-cloud, which is able to rain. The Agni who is desirable to all, ever young, lovely and radiant is the rainer of desired fruit. For him the seven dear hotṛ priests produced praise, that is, they made a hymn.

Word-to-word meaning

- विपन्या (*vipanyā*)—endowed with praise
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of water
- योना (*yonā*)—being the womb
- वृषभस्य (*vṛṣabhasya*)—of the cloud, the producer of rain
- नीळी (*nīḷī*)—in the sky, which is like a nest (you who are there in the form of lightning-fire)
- शर्धः (*śardhaḥ*)—radiance
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—beforehand
- प्र आर्त (*pra ārta*)—comes, resorting (to you)
- स्वाह्यः (*svāhyaḥ*)—first among all[?349]
- युवा (*yuvā*)—ever young
- वपुष्यः (*vapuṣyaḥ*)—one of radiant form
- विभावा (*vibhāvā*)—shining
- वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*)—for Agni, the giver of what is desired
- प्रियासः (*priyāsaḥ*)—the dear
- सप्त (*sapta*)—seven hotṛ priests
- अजनयंत (*ajanayaṃta*)—produced praise

Gist

In the sky, which is like a nest for the cloud that is the womb of water and the producer of rain, radiance first approaches you, who are there in the form of lightning-fire, and resorts to you with praise. For Agni, who is desirable to all, ever young, of radiant form, shining and the giver of what is desired, the dear seven hotṛ priests also produced praise.

English translation

Radiance has first proceeded to you, (Agni), who are glorified by praise, in the womb of the water, in the nest of the rain-cloud: the seven attached (priests) have engendered (praise) to rer (of benefit scoswh), the who is desirable, ever young, embodied, and resplendent

Special Topics

"The dear seven engendered": the meaning of this sentence is that the seven dear hotṛ priests produced praise. The seven hotṛs here are the seven officiating priests: Hotṛ, Maitrāvaruṇa, Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin, Potṛ, Neṣṭṛ, Acchāvāka and Āgnīdhra. In each of the three pressings (savana), the morning pressing, the midday pressing and the third pressing (the rite in which the soma juice is pressed out and offered in the fire according to the rule is called savana), each of these priests offers soma in the fire with one Ṛk, accompanied by vaṣaṭkāra, that is, adding the word vauṣaṭ at the end of the mantra. The rule is that the offering is made with Ṛks in the Gāyatrī metre at the morning pressing, with Ṛks in the Triṣṭubh metre at the midday pressing, and with mantras in the Jagatī metre at the third pressing. These mantras, recited by the respective priests at each pressing, are called Prasthitayājyā mantras or Saptahotra mantras. For a detailed account of this subject see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 15, p. 693.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्माक॒मत्र॑ पि॒तरो॑ मनु॒ष्या॑ अ॒भि प्र से॑दुरृ॒तमा॑शुषा॒णाः ।
अश्म॑व्रजाः सु॒दुघा॑ व॒व्रे अ॒न्तरुदु॒स्रा आ॑जन्नु॒षसो॑ हुवा॒नाः ॥ १३ ॥

> *asmākamatra pitaro manuṣyā abhi pra sedurṛtamāśuṣāṇāḥ |*
> *aśmavrajāḥ sudughā vavre antarudusrā ājannuṣaso huvānāḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्माकं । अत्र । पितरः । मनुष्याः । अभि । प्र । सेदुः । ऋतं । आशुषाणाः ।
> अश्मव्रजाः । सुदुघाः । वव्रे । अंतः । उत् । उस्राः । अजन् । उषसः । हुवानाः॥

> *asmākaṃ | atra | pitaraḥ | manuṣyāḥ | abhi | pra | seduḥ | ṛtaṃ | āśuṣāṇāḥ |*
> *aśmavrajāḥ | sudughāḥ | vavre | aṃtaḥ | ut | usrāḥ | ajan | uṣasaḥ | huvānāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अत्र लोके पूर्वे मनुष्या अस्माकं पितरोऽंगिरस यतं यज्ञमाशुषाणा
> अश्नुवानाः संतोऽभि प्र सेदुः । अग्निमभिलक्ष्य प्रजग्मुः । तेऽंगिरसोऽग्निपरिचर्याबलादश्वव्रजाः पर्वतैः परिवृता वव्रे । वृणोत्याच्छादयतीति वव्रं पर्वतविलांतवर्ति तमः । तस्मिन्नंतर्मध्ये स्थिताः सुदुघाः सुष्टु दोग्धिरुस्राः पणिभि रपहृता

> *atra loke pūrve manuṣyā asmākaṃ pitaro 'ṃgirasa yataṃ yajñamāśuṣāṇā*
> *aśnuvānāḥ saṃto 'bhi pra seduḥ | agnimabhilakṣya prajagmuḥ | te 'ṃgiraso 'gniparicaryābalādaśvavrajāḥ parvataiḥ parivṛtā vavre | vṛṇotyācchādayatīti vavraṃ parvatavilāṃtavarti tamaḥ | tasminnaṃtarmadhyè sthitāḥ sudughāḥ suṣṭu dogdhirusrāḥ paṇibhi rapahṛtā*

> गा उदाजन् । तस्माद्विलान्निरगमयन् । किं कुर्वंतः । तमसो विध्वंसनीरुषसो
> देवी: प्रकाशार्थं हुवाना आह्वयंतः ॥ वव्रे । वृणोतेरौणादिकः कः । कृणादीनां द्वे भवत इति द्विर्वचनं ॥

> *gā udājan | tasmādvilānniragamayan | kiṃ kurvaṃtaḥ | tamaso vidhvaṃsanīruṣaso*
> *devī: prakāśārthaṃ huvānā āhvayaṃtaḥ ‖ vavre | vṛṇoterauṇādikaḥ kaḥ | kṛṇādīnāṃ dve bhavata iti dvirvacanaṃ ‖*

Summary

In this world our ancestors, the Aṅgirases, men of former times, having obtained the sacrifice (ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*) = *yajñaṃ*), approached Agni: they went forth directing themselves to Agni. By the power of their service to Agni they were surrounded by mountains in the वव्रे (*vavre*). Vavra is that which covers: the darkness within the mountain cave. Standing within it, the good-milking cows (उस्राः (*usrāḥ*)) carried off by the Paṇis were driven out from that cave.

They led the cows out of that hole. What were they doing? They were calling the goddess Dawns, destroyers of darkness, for the sake of light. The rest of the block is grammar (वव्रे (*vavre*), formed from the root *vṛṇoti* with an Uṇādi affix, and its doubling).[?351]

Word-to-word meaning

- अत्र (*atra*)—in this world
- मनुष्याः (*manuṣyāḥ*)—mortal
- अस्माकं (*asmākaṃ*)—our
- पितरः (*pitaraḥ*)—fathers and grandfathers (the Aṅgirases)
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—the sacrifice
- आशुषाणाः (*āśuṣāṇāḥ*)—having established
- अभि प्र सेदुः (*abhi pra seduḥ*)—directed themselves to Agni and worshipped (that Agni, as the fruit of the worship)
- उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*)—the dawn
- हुवानाः (*huvānāḥ*)—praying to
- अश्वव्रजाः (*aśvavrajāḥ*)—surrounded by mountains
- वव्रे (*vavre*)—of the darkness
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—standing in the middle
- सुदुघाः (*sudughāḥ*)—excellent to be milked
- उस्राः (*usrāḥ*)—the cows (carried off by the Paṇis)
- उत् आजन् (*ut ājan*)—brought out

Gist

O Agni, in this world our mortal fathers and grandfathers, the Aṅgirases, established the sacrifice and worshipped you with it in view. As the fruit of that worship they prayed to the Dawn, obtained light, and brought out of the cave the cows that lay hidden in darkness among the mountains, cows excellent to be milked.

English translation

In this world our mortal forefathers departed after instituting the sacred rite, when, calling upon the dawn, they extricated the milk-yielding cows, concealed among the rocks in the darkness (of the cave).

Special Topics

In this Ṛk and in the next two Ṛks it is told how the Paṇis, a class of asuras, carried off the cows of the Aṅgirasa seers and hid them in a mountain cave, and how the Aṅgirasa seers freed them by the power of their mantras. We have explained this subject at length in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 8 p. 189, Part 6 p. 365, Part 10 p. 577 and other places. The reason why the matter of the Aṅgirasa seers comes into this sūkta, which concerns Agni, we have explained at length in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 1 pp. 640-641.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ते म॑र्मृजत ददृ॒वांसो॒ अद्रिं॒ तदे॑षाम॒न्ये अ॒भितो॒ वि वो॑चन् ।
प॒श्वयं॑न्त्रासो अ॒भि का॒रम॑र्चन्वि॒दन्त॒ ज्योति॑श्चकृ॒पन्त॑ धी॒भिः ॥ १४ ॥

> *te marmṛjata dadṛvāṃso adriṃ tadeṣāmanye abhito vi vocan |*
> *paśvayantrāso abhi kāramarcanvidanta jyotiścakṛpanta dhībhiḥ ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ते । मर्मृजत । ददृवांसः । अद्रिं । तत् । विषां । अन्ये । अभितः । वि । वोचन् ।
> पश्वयंत्रासः । अभि । कारं । अर्चन् । विदंत । ज्योतिः । चकृपंत । धीभिः ॥ १४ ॥

> *te | marmṛjata | dadṛvāṃsaḥ | adriṃ | tat | viṣāṃ | anye | abhitaḥ | vi | vocan |*
> *paśvayaṃtrāsaḥ | abhi | kāraṃ | arcan | vidaṃta | jyotiḥ | cakṛpaṃta | dhībhiḥ ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> तेऽंगिरसोऽद्रिं पणिभिरपहृतानां गवां निरोधकं पर्वतं दद्ववांसो
> विदारयंतः संतो मर्मृजत । अग्निं पर्यचरन् । एषामंगिरसां तत्तादृशं
> कर्मान्ये महर्षयोऽभितः सर्वत्र जगति वि वोचन् । विशेषेणाकथयन् । पश्वयंत्रासः
> पशुनिर्गमनार्थानि यंत्राण्युपाया येषां तेऽंगिरसः कारमभिमतस्य
> प्रयोजनस्य कर्तारमग्निमभ्यर्चन् । अस्तुवन् । ततस्तमोपहमादित्याख्यं ज्योतिर्विदंत ।
> अलभंत । ततो धीभिर्बुद्धिभिश्च कृसंत । यज्ञानकल्पयन्नकुर्वन् ॥ मर्मृजत । मृजूष् शुद्धौ ।
> यज्लुकि लजं व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । निघातः । चकृपंत ।
> कृपू सामर्थ्ये । ण्यंतस्य लुजः चजः सन्वद्भावाभावश्चांदसः ॥

> *te 'ṃgiraso 'driṃ paṇibhirapahṛtānāṃ gavāṃ nirodhakaṃ parvataṃ dadvavāṃso*
> *vidārayaṃtaḥ saṃto marmṛjata | agniṃ paryacaran | eṣāmaṃgirasāṃ tattādṛśaṃ*
> *karmānye maharṣayo 'bhitaḥ sarvatra jagati vi vocan |*
> *viśeṣeṇākathayan | paśvayaṃtrāsaḥ paśunirgamanārthāni*
> *yaṃtrāṇyupāyā yeṣāṃ te 'ṃgirasaḥ kāramabhimatasya*
> *prayojanasya kartāramagnimabhyarcan | astuvan |*
> *tatastamopahamādityākhyaṃ jyotirvidaṃta | alabhaṃta | tato*
> *dhībhirbuddhibhiśca kṛsaṃta | yajñānakalpayannakurvan ‖ marmṛjata | mṛjūṣ śuddhau | yajluki lajaṃ vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | nighātaḥ | cakṛpaṃta |*
> *kṛpū sāmarthye | ṇyaṃtasya lujaḥ cajaḥ sanvadbhāvābhāvaścāṃdasaḥ ‖*

Summary

Those Aṅgirases split the mountain (अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)), which blocked the cows carried off by the Paṇis, and so served Agni (मर्मृजत (*marmṛjata*)). That deed of theirs other great seers proclaimed everywhere in the world, they spoke it forth specially. The पश्वयंत्रासः (*paśvayaṃtrāsaḥ*) are those whose devices and means are for bringing the cattle out; these Aṅgirases praised Agni, the maker (कारं (*kāraṃ*)) of the desired aim. Then they found the light called Āditya, which removes darkness.

Then with their thoughts and intellects they arranged and performed the sacrifices. The rest of the block is grammar (मर्मृजत (*marmṛjata*) from the root मृजूष् शुद्धौ (*mṛjūṣ śuddhau*), चकृपंत (*cakṛpaṃta*) from कृपू सामर्थ्ये (*kṛpū sāmarthye*)).[?352]

Word-to-word meaning

- ते (*te*)—those Aṅgirases
- अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)—the rocks of the mountain that had blocked the cows
- ददृवांसः (*dadṛvāṃsaḥ*)—splitting
- मर्मृजत (*marmṛjata*)—served Agni
- एषां (*eṣāṃ*)—of these Aṅgirases
- तत् (*tat*)—that great deed
- अन्ये (*anye*)—other seers
- अभितः (*abhitaḥ*)—everywhere
- वि वोचन् (*vi vocan*)—praised greatly
- पश्वयंत्रासः (*paśvayaṃtrāsaḥ*)—the Aṅgirases, who knew the means needed for the cattle's coming out
- कारं (*kāraṃ*)—Agni, the accomplisher of what is desired
- अर्चन् (*arcan*)—praised (and afterwards)
- ज्योतिः (*jyotiḥ*)—the light in the form of the sun
- विदंत (*vidaṃta*)—obtained
- धीभिः (*dhībhiḥ*)—with their intelligences
- चकृसंत (*cakṛsaṃta*)—carried out sacrifices and the like

Gist

The Aṅgirases, splitting the rocks of the mountain that had blocked the cows, served Agni. That great deed of the Aṅgirases was praised greatly by other seers in every place. The Aṅgirases, who knew the means needed for the cattle's coming out, praised Agni, the accomplisher of what is desired. Afterwards they obtained the light in the form of the sun. With their intelligences they carried out sacrifices and other rites.

English translation

Rending the rocks, they worshipped (Agni), and other (sages) taught everywhere their (acts): unprovided with the means of (extricating) the cattle, they glorified the author of success, whence they found the light, and were thus enabled (to worship him) with holy ceremonies:

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ते गं॑व्य॒ता मनं॑सा दृ॒ध्रमु॒ब्धं गा ये॑मा॒नं प॒रि षन्त॒मद्रिं॑म् ।
दृ॒ळ्हं नरो॒ वचं॑सा॒ दैव्ये॑न व्र॒जं गोमं॑न्तमु॒शिजो॒ वि वं॑व्रुः ॥ १५ ॥

> *te gavyatā manasā dṛdhramubdhaṃ gā yemānaṃ pari ṣantamadrim |*
> *dṛḷhaṃ naro vacasā daivyena vrajaṃ gomantamuśijo vi vavruḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ते । गव्यता । मनसा । दृढं । उब्धं । गाः । येमानं । परि । संतं । आद्रिं ।
> दृढं । नरः । वचसा । दैव्येन । व्रजं । गोऽमंतं । उशिजः । वि । ववुरिति
> ववुः ॥ १५ ॥

> *te | gavyatā | manasā | dṛḍhaṃ | ubdhaṃ | gāḥ | yemānaṃ | pari | saṃtaṃ | ādriṃ |*
> *dṛḍhaṃ | naraḥ | vacasā | daivyena | vrajaṃ | go 'maṃtaṃ | uśijaḥ | vi | vavuriti*
> *vavuḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> नरः कर्मणां नेतार उशिजोऽग्निं कामयमानास्तेऽंगिरसो गव्यता गा
> इच्छता मनसा दृढं गवां निर्गमनद्वारनिरोधकमुब्धं समुब्धं संहतं । यद्वा ।
> उभिः पूर्णार्थः । गोभिः पूर्णं गा येमानं नियच्छंतं परि सर्वतः संतं वर्तमानं धृढं दृढं गोमंतं
> गोभिर्युक्तं व्रजं गवां निवासस्थानमद्रिं पर्वतं
> दैव्येनाग्निं विषयेण वचसा वेदात्मकेन स्तोत्रेण वि ववुः । गोनिर्गमनार्थमु–

> *naraḥ karmaṇāṃ netāra uśijo 'gniṃ kāmayamānāste 'ṃgiraso gavyatā gā*
> *icchatā manasā dṛḍhaṃ gavāṃ nirgamanadvāranirodhakamubdhaṃ samubdhaṃ saṃhataṃ | yadvā |*
> *ubhiḥ pūrṇārthaḥ | gobhiḥ pūrṇaṃ gā yemānaṃ niyacchaṃtaṃ pari sarvataḥ saṃtaṃ vartamānaṃ dhṛḍhaṃ dṛḍhaṃ gomaṃtaṃ gobhiryuktaṃ vrajaṃ gavāṃ nivāsasthānamadriṃ parvataṃ daivyenāgni viṣayeṇa vacasā vedātmakena stotreṇa vi vavuḥ |*
> *gonirgamanārthamu-*

> द्वापितवंतः ॥ उब्धं । उभ्नातिर्हंतिना समानार्थः । यद्वा । उभ उन्फ पूरणे ।
> कर्मणि क्तः । येमानं । यमेः कानच्यत्वाभ्यासलोप् । चित्तादंतोदात्तः ।
> परि षंतमित्यत्र संहितायामुपसर्गप्रादुर्भ्यामस्तियर्च्पर इति षत्वं ॥

> *dvāpitavaṃtaḥ ‖ ubdhaṃ | ubhnātirhaṃtinā samānārthaḥ | yadvā | ubha unpha pūraṇe |*
> *karmaṇi ktaḥ | yemānaṃ | yameḥ kānacyatvābhyāsalop | cittādaṃtodāttaḥ |*
> *pari ṣaṃtamityatra saṃhitāyāmupasargaprādurbhyāmastiyarcpara iti ṣatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The नरः (*naraḥ*) are the leaders of rites; the उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*) are those who desire Agni. These Aṅgirases, with a mind wishing for cows (गव्यता (*gavyatā*)), opened with divine speech (*daivyena vacasā*), that is, with praise on Agni's subject, of the nature of the Veda, the mountain (अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)). That mountain was firm (दृढं (*dṛḍhaṃ*), also read धृढं (*dhṛḍhaṃ*)), and was उब्धं (*ubdhaṃ*), that is, closed and compact, because it blocked the door by which the cows go out. Or else उभिः (*ubhiḥ*) has the sense "full": it was full of cows, and held the cows (गा येमानं (*gā yemānaṃ*)), standing all around. It was a cow-pen (व्रजं (*vrajaṃ*)) with cows, the abode of cows. They made it open (वि ववुः (*vi vavuḥ*)), they caused it to be opened for the cows to go out.

उब्धं (*ubdhaṃ*): the root उभ्नाति (*ubhnāti*) has the same sense as हंति (*haṃti*). Or else the root is *ubha uṃbha pūraṇe* with the passive affix क्तः (*ktaḥ*). The remainder of the block is grammar (येमानं (*yemānaṃ*), accent, the change of s to ṣ in परि । संतं (*pari | saṃtaṃ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- नरः (*naraḥ*)—leaders of rites
- उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*)—those who look for Agni's help
- ते (*te*)—the Aṅgirases
- गव्यता मनसा (*gavyatā manasā*)—with a mind wishing to obtain cows
- दृढं (*dṛḍhaṃ*)—that which is to be an obstruction
- उब्बं (*ubbaṃ*)—that which is to be a pressure
- गा येमानं (*gā yemānaṃ*)—that which is to hold the cows back
- परि (*pari*)—around
- संतं (*saṃtaṃ*)—that which is to be pervading
- दृळ्हं (*dṛḷhaṃ*)—that which is to be hard
- गोमंतं (*gomaṃtaṃ*)—that which is to be full of cows
- व्रजं (*vrajaṃ*)—that which is to be the abode of cows
- अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)—the mountain
- दैव्येन (*daivyena*)—concerning Agni
- वचसा (*vacasā*)—with the help of praises
- वि ववुः (*vi vavuḥ*)—split open and freed

Gist

The Aṅgirases, leaders of rites, who looked for Agni's help, desiring to obtain the cows, split open and freed, with the help of praises addressed to Agni, the entrance of the mountain. It was an obstruction holding the cows back, a pressure, pervading all around, hard, and in the form of a cow-pen for the cows.

English translation

Devoted (to Agni), those leaders (of sacred rites), with minds intent upon (recovering) the cattle, forced open, by (the power) of divine prayer, the obstructing, compact, solid mountain confining the cows, a cow-pen full of cows.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ते मं॑न्वत प्रथ॒मं नाम॑ धे॒नोस्त्रिः स॒प्त मा॒तुः प॑र॒माणि॑ विन्दन् ।
तज्ञा॑न॒तीर॒भ्यं॑नूषत॒ व्रा आ॒विर्भु॑वदरु॒णीर्य॒शसा॒ गोः
॥ १६ ॥

> *te manvata prathamaṃ nāma dhenostriḥ sapta mātuḥ paramāṇi vindan |*
> *tajjānatīrabhyanūṣata vrā āvirbhuvadaruṇīryaśasā goḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शे । मन्वत । प्रथमं । नाम । धेनोः । त्रिः । सप्त । मातुः । परमाणि । विंदन् ।
> तत् । जानतीः । अभि । अनुषत । व्राः । आविः । भुवत् । अरुणीः । यशसा । गोः । १६॥

> *śe | manvata | prathamaṃ | nāma | dhenoḥ | triḥ | sapta | mātuḥ | paramāṇi | viṃdan |*
> *tat | jānatīḥ | abhi | anuṣata | vrāḥ | āviḥ | bhuvat | aruṇīḥ | yaśasā | goḥ | 16‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ते स्तोत्रं कुर्वाणा अंगिरसो मातुर्जनन्या धेनोर्वाचः
> संबंधि नाम स्तुतिसाधकं शब्दमात्रं प्रथमं पूर्वं मन्वत । अजानत । पश्चात्तस्या
> वाचः संबंधीनि त्रिः सप्तैकविंशतिसंख्याकानि स्तुतिसाधनानि छंदांसि । तानि च गायत्रादीनि
> जगत्यंतानि सप्त । अतिजगत्यादीन्यतिधृत्यंतानि सप्त । कृतिप्रभृतीनुत्कृतिपर्यंतानि सप्तेति ।
> एवं त्रिः सप्त छंदांसि परमाण्युत्तमानि विंदन् । अलभंत ।
> एवंविधच्छंदोयुक्तैर्मंत्रैरग्निमस्तुवन्नित्यर्थः । तत्ततो जानतीः सर्वं जानाना
> व्याः । व्या इत्युषोनाम । उषसोऽभ्यनूषत । अस्तुवन् । ततो गोः सूर्यस्य
> यशसा तेजसा सहारुणीररुणवर्णोषा आविर्भुवत् अविरभूत् । यद्वा । तेऽगिरसः प्रथमं पुरातनं
> नाम एहि सुरभि गुग्गुलु गंधिनीति धेनोर्नामधेयं मन्वत
> उच्चारयामासुः । मातुर्भूम्याः स्वभूतानि पणिभिरपहृतानि त्रिः सप्त रत्नानि
> विंदन् । तत उच्चरितं नाम जानंत्यो गावोऽभ्यनूषत । हंभारवलक्षणं शब्दमकुर्वन् ।
> तदानीमुषाः प्रादुरभूदिति ॥ जानतीः । एकस्मिन्पक्षे वा छंदसीति पूर्वसवर्णदीर्घः । उभयत्र

> शतुरनुमो नद्यजादीति जीप उदात्तत्वं । अनूषत । णु स्तुता । लुजः रूपं । कुटादित्वदगुणः । अरुणीः । सोरलोपश्चांदसो गौरीर्मिमाय । ऋग्वे. १–१६४–४१ । इतिवत् ॥

> *he agne te stotraṃ kurvāṇā aṃgiraso māturjananyā dhenorvācaḥ saṃbaṃdhi nāma stutisādhakaṃ śabdamātraṃ prathamaṃ pūrvaṃ manvata | ajānata | paścāttasyā vācaḥ saṃbaṃdhīni triḥ saptaikaviṃśatisaṃkhyākāni stutisādhanāni chaṃdāṃsi | tāni ca gāyatrādīni jagatyaṃtāni sapta | atijagatyādīnyatidhṛtyaṃtāni sapta | kṛtiprabhṛtīnutkṛtiparyaṃtāni sapteti | evaṃ triḥ sapta chaṃdāṃsi paramāṇyuttamāni viṃdan | alabhaṃta | evaṃvidhacchaṃdoyuktairmaṃtrairagnimastuvannityarthaḥ | tattato jānatīḥ sarvaṃ jānānā vyāḥ | vyā ityuṣonāma | uṣaso 'bhyanūṣata | astuvan | tato goḥ sūryasya yaśasā tejasā sahāruṇīraruṇavarṇoṣā āvirbhuvat avirabhūt | yadvā | te 'ṃgirasaḥ prathamaṃ purātanaṃ nāma ehi surabhi guggulu gaṃdhinīti dhenornāmadheyaṃ manvata uccārayāmāsuḥ | māturbhūmyāḥ svabhūtāni paṇibhirapahṛtāni triḥ sapta ratnāni viṃdan | tata uccaritaṃ nāma jānaṃtyo gāvo 'bhyanūṣata | haṃbhāravalakṣaṇaṃ śabdamakurvan | tadānīmuṣāḥ prādurabhūditi ‖ jānatīḥ | ekasminpakṣe vā chaṃdasīti pūrvasavarṇadīrghaḥ | ubhayatra śaturanumo nadyajādīti jīpa udāttatvaṃ | anūṣata | ṇu stutā | lujaḥ rūpaṃ | kuṭāditvadaguṇaḥ | aruṇīḥ | soralopaścāṃdaso gaurīrmimāya | ṛgve. 1-164-41 | itivat ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, the Angirases who praise you first thought (मन्वत (*manvata*), i.e. came to know) the name, the mere word serving as a means of praise, belonging to the cow (धेनोः (*dhenoḥ*)), the mother, that is Speech. Afterwards they found (विंदन् (*viṃdan*), obtained) the thrice seven (twenty-one) supreme, excellent metres belonging to that Speech and serving as means of praise. These are: seven from Gāyatrī to Jagatī; seven from Atijagatī to Atidhṛti; seven from Kṛti to Utkṛti. The meaning is that they praised Agni with mantras furnished with metres of this kind. Then, knowing everything, they praised (अभ्यनूषत (*abhyanūṣata*)) the व्राः (*vrāḥ*) (व्रा (*vrā*) is a name of Uṣas), the dawns. Then, with the glory, the brilliance, of the sun (गोः (*goḥ*)), the ruddy dawn of reddish colour became manifest."

Alternatively: those Angirases uttered the first, the ancient name of the cow — "Come, fragrant one, guggulu-scented one" (एहि सुरभि गुग्गुलु गंधिनीति (*ehi surabhi guggulu gaṃdhinīti*)). They found the thrice seven jewels belonging to Mother Earth and carried off by the Paṇis. Then the cows, knowing the name that had been uttered, lowed, making the sound "haṃbhā". Then Uṣas appeared. (The rest of the block is grammatical: the forms जानतीः (*jānatīḥ*), अनूषत (*anūṣata*) and अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*), the last compared with गौरीर्मिमाय (*gaurīrmimāya*), Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-41.)

Word-to-word meaning

- ते (*te*)—the praising Angirases (O Agni)
- मातुः (*mātuḥ*)—of the (cow) in the form of the mother
- धेनोः (*dhenoḥ*)—belonging to speech, in the form of praise
- नाम (*nāma*)—only the nature of the word
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—first
- मन्वत (*manvata*)—understood; (afterwards)
- त्रिः सप्त (*triḥ sapta*)—twenty-one in number
- परमाणि (*paramāṇi*)—excellent; the metres
- विंदन् (*viṃdan*)—they came to know
- तत् (*tat*)—thereafter
- जानतीः (*jānatīḥ*)—the all-knowing
- व्राः (*vrāḥ*)—Uṣas-es
- अभ्यनूषत (*abhyanūṣata*)—they praised
- गोः (*goḥ*)—of the Āditya (sun)
- यशसा (*yaśasā*)—together with the radiance
- अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*)—the golden-hued Uṣas
- आविर्भुवत् (*āvirbhuvat*)—became manifest

Gist

O Agni, the praising Angirases first came to know only the nature of the word of praise, which is in the form of the mother. Afterwards they came to know the twenty-one excellent metres. Then they praised the all-knowing dawns. United with the radiance of the Āditya, the golden-hued Uṣas became manifest.

English translation

They first have comprehended the name of the cows, knowing the thrice seven excellent (forms) of the maternal (rhythm); then they glorified the conscious dawns, and the purple dawn appeared with the radiance of the sun.

Special Topics

The commentator explains त्रिः सप्त परमाणि (*triḥ sapta paramāṇi*) as twenty-one metres. They are as follows.

I. गायत्र्यादीनि जगत्त्यंतानि सप्त (*gāyatryādīni jagattyaṃtāni sapta*)—the seven metres from Gāyatrī up to Jagatī: (1) Gāyatrī (2) Uṣṇik (3) Anuṣṭup (4) Bṛhatī (5) Paṅktiḥ (6) Triṣṭup (7) Jagatī.

1. अतिजगत्यादीन्यतिधृत्यंतानि सप्त (*atijagatyādīnyatidhṛtyaṃtāni sapta*)—the seven metres from Atijagatī up to Atidhṛti: (1) Atijagatī (2) Śakvarī (3) Atiśakvarī (4) Aṣṭiḥ (5) Atyaṣṭiḥ (6) Dhṛtiḥ (7) Atidhṛtiḥ.
2. कृतिप्रभृतीन्युत्कृतिपर्यंतानि सप्त (*kṛtiprabhṛtīnyutkṛtiparyaṃtāni sapta*)—the seven metres from the metre Kṛti up to Utkṛti: (1) Kṛtiḥ (2) Prakṛtiḥ (3) Ākṛtiḥ (4) Vikṛtiḥ (5) Saṃkṛtiḥ (6) Abhikṛtiḥ (7) Utkṛtiḥ.

The sense is that these three groups together make twenty-one kinds of metres.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नेश॒त्तमो॒ दुधि॑तं॒ रोच॑त॒ द्यौरुद्दे॒व्या उ॒षसो॑ भा॒नुर॑र्त
।
आ सूर्यो॑ बृह॒तस्ति॑ष्ठ॒दज्राँ॑ ऋ॒जु मर्ते॑षु वृजि॒ना च॒
पश्य॑न् ॥ १७ ॥

> *neśattamo dudhitaṃ rocata dyauruddevyā uṣaso bhānurarta |*
> *ā sūryo bṛhatastiṣṭhadajrā~ ṛju marteṣu vṛjinā ca paśyan ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नेशत् । तमः । दुधितं । रोचत । द्यौः । उत् । देव्याः । उषसः । भानुः । अर्त ।
> आ । सूर्यः । बृगतः । तिष्ठत् । अज्रान् । ऋजु । मर्तेषु । वृजिना । च । पश्यन् ॥

> *neśat | tamaḥ | dudhitaṃ | rocata | dyauḥ | ut | devyāḥ | uṣasaḥ | bhānuḥ | arta |*
> *ā | sūryaḥ | bṛgataḥ | tiṣṭhat | ajrān | ṛju | marteṣu | vṛjinā | ca | paśyan ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> तमो रात्रिकृतं ध्वांतं दुधितं । दुधिः प्रेरणकर्मा । प्रातरग्नि विहरणकाल
> उषसा प्रेरितं सत् नेशत् । अनश्यत । ततो द्यौरंतरिक्षं रोचत । अदीप्यत । ततो
> देव्या देवनशीलाया उषसो भानुः प्रभोदर्त । उद्गच्छति । अथ सूरो बृहतो
> महतोऽज्रानजरान्पर्वतान् गमनशीलान्प्रश्मीन्वा तिष्ठत् । अध्यतिष्ठत् । किं कुर्वन्
> मर्तेषु मनुष्येषु विद्यमानमृजु सत्कर्म वृजिनानृजून्यसत्कर्माणि च पश्यन् ।
> अध्यतिष्ठदिति शेषः ॥ नेशत् । णश आदर्शने । लजि णशिमन्वयोरलिट्यचेत्वं वक्तव्यमित्येत्वं
> । शपः पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । रोचत । रुच दीप्तौ । लजि रूपं ।
> वाक्यभेदादनिघातः ॥

> *tamo rātrikṛtaṃ dhvāṃtaṃ dudhitaṃ | dudhiḥ preraṇakarmā |*
> *prātaragni viharaṇakāla*
> *uṣasā preritaṃ sat neśat | anaśyata | tato dyauraṃtarikṣaṃ rocata |*
> *adīpyata | tato*

> *devyā devanaśīlāyā uṣaso bhānuḥ prabhodarta | uddacchati | atha sūro bṛhato*
> *mahato 'jrānajarānparvatān gamanaśīlānpraśmīnvā tiṣṭhat | adhyatiṣṭhat | kiṃ kurvan*
> *marteṣu manuṣyeṣu vidyamānamṛju satkarma vṛjinānṛjūnyasatkarmāṇi ca paśyan |*
> *adhyatiṣṭhaditi śeṣaḥ ‖ neśat | ṇaśa ādarśane | laji ṇaśimanvayoralitiyetvaṃ vaktavyamityetvaṃ | śapaḥ pitvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | rocata | ruca dīptau | laji rūpaṃ | vākyabhedādanighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

The darkness (तमः (*tamaḥ*)) is the gloom made by night; दुधितं (*dudhitaṃ*): दुधिः (*dudhiḥ*) has the sense of impelling. At the time of Agni's morning kindling, impelled by Uṣas, it perished (नेशत् (*neśat*)). Then the sky (द्यौः (*dyauḥ*), the atmosphere) shone (रोचत (*rocata*)). Then the light of the shining goddess Uṣas rose up (अर्त (*arta*)). Then the sun stood over (तिष्ठत् (*tiṣṭhat*), "stood upon") the great, unaging mountains, or the moving rays (अज्रान् (*ajrān*)). Doing what? Beholding the straight (ऋजु (*ṛju*)), good deeds existing among mortals, and the crooked, bad deeds. "He stood upon" is the word to be supplied. (The rest of the block is grammatical, on नेशत् (*neśat*) and रोचत (*rocata*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- तमः (*tamaḥ*)—the pitch darkness
- दुधितं (*dudhitaṃ*)—driven away (by Uṣas)
- नेशत् (*neśat*)—was destroyed
- दौः (*dauḥ*)—the atmosphere
- रोचत (*rocata*)—shone
- देव्याः (*devyāḥ*)—of the shining
- उपसः (*upasaḥ*)—Uṣas
- भानुः (*bhānuḥ*)—the light
- उत आर्त (*uta ārta*)—spreads upward
- सूर्यः (*sūryaḥ*)—the Āditya
- मर्तेषु (*marteṣu*)—among men
- ऋजु (*ṛju*)—the straightforward deeds

- वृजना च (*vṛjanā ca*)—and the deceitful acts
- पश्यन् (*paśyan*)—beholding
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—great
- अज्रान् (*ajrān*)—the undecaying rays
- आ तिष्ठत् (*ā tiṣṭhat*)—having obtained, shines

Gist

The pitch darkness, driven away by Uṣas, was destroyed. The atmosphere shone. The light of Uṣas spreads upward. The Āditya, beholding the straightforward deeds and the deceitful acts that go on among men, obtains the great and undecaying rays and shines.

English translation

The scattered darkness was destroyed; the firmament glowed with radiance ; the lustre of the divine dawn arose : then the sun stood above the undecaying mountains, beholding all that was right or wrong among mankind.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आदित्प॒श्चा बुं॑बुधा॒ना व्यं॑ख्य॒न्नादिद्रत्नं॑ धारयन्त॒ द्युभं॑क्तम् ।
विश्वे॒ विश्वां॑सु॒ दुर्यां॑सु दे॒वा मित्रं॑ धि॒ये वं॑रुण स॒त्यमं॑स्तु ॥ १८ ॥

> *āditpaścā bubudhānā vyakhyannādidratnaṃ dhārayanta dyubhaktam |*
> *viśve viśvāsu duryāsu devā mitra dhiye varuṇa satyamastu ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आत् । इत् । पश्चा । बुबुधानाः । वि । अख्यन् । आत् । इत् । रत्नं । धारयंत ।
> द्युभक्तं ।
> विश्वे । विश्वासु । दुर्यासु । देवाः । मित्र । धिये । वरुण । सत्यं । अस्तु ॥ १८ ॥

> *āt | it | paścā | bubudhānāḥ | vi | akhyan | āt | it | ratnaṃ |*
> *dhārayaṃta |*
> *dyubhaktaṃ |*
> *viśve | viśvāsu | duryāsu | devāḥ | mitra | dhiye | varuṇa | satyaṃ |*
> *astu ‖ 18 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आदित्सूर्योदयादनंतरं बुबुधानाः पणिभिरपहृता निरोधान्निर्गता गा
> जानाना अंगिरसः पश्चा पृष्यदेशेषु व्यख्यन् । अशेषेण ता गा अपश्यन् । तथादिदनंतरं द्युभक्तं
> दीप्तियुक्तं देवैः संभक्तं वा रत्नं पणिभिरपहृतं धनं च धारयंत । आधारयन् ।
> लब्धगोधनानामंगिरसां विश्वासु दुर्यासु सर्वेषु गृहेषु
> विश्वे यजनीयाः सर्वे देवा आजग्मुः । हे मित्र मित्रभूत हे वरुणोपद्रवाणां
> वारक हे अग्ने धिये कर्मणां कर्त्रे स्तोत्रे वा यजमानाय सत्यमस्तु ।
> यदेतत्तवोपद्रववारणसामर्थ्यं तद्यथार्थभूतमस्तु ॥ पश्चा । पश्च पश्चा च छंदसीति
> निपातितः । बुबुधानाः । बुधेर्लिटि कानचि रूपं । चित्वादंतोदात्तः । द्युभक्तं ।
> भज सेवायां । कर्मणि क्तः । तृतीया कर्मणीति पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *āditsūryodayādanaṃtaraṃ bubudhānāḥ paṇibhirapahṛtā*
> *nirodhānnirgatā gā*
> *jānānā aṃgirasaḥ paścā pṛṣyadeśeṣu vyakhyan | aśeṣeṇa tā gā apaśyan*
> *| tathādidanaṃtaraṃ dyubhaktaṃ dīptiyuktaṃ devaiḥ saṃbhaktaṃ vā*
> *ratnaṃ paṇibhirapahṛtaṃ dhanaṃ ca dhārayaṃta | ādhārayan |*
> *labdhagodhanānāmaṃgirasāṃ viśvāsu duryāsu sarveṣu gṛheṣu*
> *viśve yajanīyāḥ sarvè devā ājagmuḥ | he mitra mitrabhūta he*
> *varuṇopadravāṇāṃ*
> *vāraka he agne dhiye karmaṇāṃ kartrè stotre vā yajamānāya*
> *satyamastu | yadetattavopadravavāraṇasāmarthyaṃ*
> *tadyathārthabhūtamastu ‖ paścā | paśca paścā ca chaṃdasīti*
> *nipātitaḥ | bubudhānāḥ | budherliṭi kānaci rūpaṃ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ |*
> *dyubhaktaṃ |*
> *bhaja sevāyāṃ | karmaṇi ktaḥ | tṛtīyā karmaṇīti*
> *pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

आदित् (*ādit*): after sunrise the Angirases, awakened (बुबुधानाः (*bubudhānāḥ*)), knowing the cows that had been carried off by the Paṇis and had come out of confinement, saw them (व्यख्यन्

(*vyakhyan*)) completely, in the rear regions (पश्चा (*paścā*)). Then, immediately after, they took hold of (धारयंत (*dhārayaṃta*)) the treasure (रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)), radiant (द्युभक्तं (*dyubhaktaṃ*)) or shared by the gods, wealth carried off by the Paṇis. In all the houses (दुर्यासु (*duryāsu*)) of the Angirases who had regained their cows, all (विश्वे (*viśve*)) the gods, the worthy of sacrifice, came. O Mitra, who are as a friend; O Varuṇa, warder-off of troubles; O Agni: for the sacrificer, the doer of rites, or the praiser, let it be true (सत्यमस्तु (*satyamastu*)) — let this power of yours to ward off troubles be real. (The rest of the block is grammatical: पश्चा (*paścā*), बुबुधानाः (*bubudhānāḥ*), द्युभक्तं (*dyubhaktaṃ*).)

Word-to-word meaning

- आदित् (*ādit*)—right after sunrise
- बुबुधानाः (*bubudhānāḥ*)—the Angirases who had come to know the cows
- पश्चा (*paścā*)—behind them
- व्यख्यन् (*vyakhyan*)—saw the cows
- आदित् (*ādit*)—immediately
- द्युभक्तं (*dyubhaktaṃ*)—radiant
- रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)—wealth
- धारयंत (*dhārayaṃta*)—obtained
- विश्वासु (*viśvāsu*)—in all
- दुरासु (*durāsu*)—in the sacrificial houses
- विश्वे देवाः (*viśve devāḥ*)—all the gods came and gathered
- मित्र (*mitra*)—O friend
- वरुण (*varuṇa*)—O Varuṇa, destroyer of harms (Agni)
- धियें (*dhiye*)—to the praising sacrificer
- सत्यं अस्तु (*satyaṃ astu*)—let there be a life of truth

Gist

Only after sunrise did the Angirases see their cows. At once they obtained radiant wealth. In all the sacrificial houses all the gods came and gathered. O Mitra and Varuṇa, by your grace let the praising sacrificer have a life of truth.

English translation

Thereupon awaking, the (Angirasas) beheld (the cattle set free), and seized upon the precious treasures: the universal gods then came to all (their) dwellings: Mitra and Varuna, may your truth be (kept) to him who worships (you).

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अच्छा॑ वोचेय शुशुचा॒नम॒ग्निं होता॑रं वि॒श्वभ॑रसं॒ यजि॑ष्ठम् ।
शुच्यूधो॑ अतृ॒ण॒न्न गवा॒मन्धो॒ न पू॒तं परि॑षिक्तमं॒शोः ॥ १९ ॥

> *acchā voceya śuśucānamagniṃ hotāraṃ viśvabharasaṃ yajiṣṭham |*
> *śucyūdho atṛṇanna gavāmandho na pūtaṃ pariṣiktamaṃśoḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अच्छ । वोचेय । शुशुचानं । अग्निं । होतारं । विश्वभरसं । यजिष्ठं ।
> शुचि । ऊधः । अतृणत् । न । गवां । अंधः । न । पूतं । परिऽसिक्तं । अंशोः ॥ १९ ॥

> *accha | voceya | śuśucānaṃ | agniṃ | hotāraṃ | viśvabharasaṃ | yajiṣṭhaṃ |*
> *śuci | ūdhaḥ | atṛṇat | na | gavāṃ | aṃdhaḥ | na | pūtaṃ | pari 'siktaṃ | aṃśoḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने शुशुचानं भृशं दीप्यमानं होतारं देवानामाह्वातारं विश्वभरसमाहुतिद्वारा वृष्टिप्रदानेन विश्वस्य पोषकं यजिष्ठं यष्टृतममग्निं त्वामच्छाभिलक्ष्य वोचेय । स्तवानि । गवामूधः शुचि शुद्धं पयो नातृणत् । तवाहुत्यर्थं यजमानो न दोग्दि । अंशोः सोमलताखंडस्य संबंध्यंधो रसाख्यमन्नं पूतं दशापवित्रेण शोधितं सत् न परिषिक्तं । गृहेषु न प्रक्षिप्तं । किंत्वनेन.

> *he agne śuśucānaṃ bhṛśaṃ dīpyamānaṃ hotāraṃ devānāmāhvātāraṃ viśvabharasamāhutidvārā vṛṣṭipradānena viśvasya poṣakaṃ yajiṣṭhaṃ yaṣṭṛtamamagniṃ tvāmacchābhilakṣya voceya | stavāni | gavāmūdhaḥ śuci śuddhaṃ payo nātṛṇat | tavāhutyarthaṃ yajamāno na dogdi | aṃśoḥ somalatākhaṃḍasya saṃbaṃdhyaṃdho rasākhyamannaṃ pūtaṃ daśāpavitreṇa śodhitaṃ sat na pariṣiktaṃ | gṛheṣu na prakṣiptaṃ | kiṃtvanena.*

> यजमानेन केवलं स्तुतिरेव क्रियते ॥ पोचे॑य । ब्रूञ् आशीर्लिजं ब्रुवो वचिः ।
> लिङ्शिष्यज् । छंदस्युभयथेति सार्वधातुकत्वात्सीयुटः सलोपः । अतृणत् । उत्दिर्
> हिंसानादरयोः । दोहनमेवोधोहिंसनं । परिषिक्तं । सिंचतेः कर्मणि
> क्तः उपसर्गात्सुनोतीति संहितायां षत्वं । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः स्वरः ॥

> *yajamānena kevalaṃ stutireva kriyate ‖ pocèya | brūñ āśīrlijaṃ bruvo vaciḥ |*
> *liṅśiṣyaj | chaṃdasyubhayatheti sārvadhātukatvātsīyuṭaḥ salopaḥ |*
> *atṛṇat | utdir hiṃsānādarayoḥ | dohanamevodhohiṃsanaṃ |*
> *pariṣiktaṃ | siṃcateḥ karmaṇi*
> *ktaḥ upasargātsunotīti saṃhitāyāṃ ṣatvaṃ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ svaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you who blaze brightly (शुशुचानं (*śuśucānaṃ*)), the Hotṛ, caller of the gods, विश्वभरसं (*viśvabharasaṃ*) — nourisher of the whole world by granting rain through the oblation — the most worshipful (यजिष्ठं (*yajiṣṭhaṃ*)): I would address (वोचेय (*voceya*), praise) you (अच्छ (*accha*), directing myself towards you). The udder of the cows, pure milk, has not been milked (अतृणत् (*atṛṇat*)): the sacrificer does not milk for your oblation. The food (अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*)), the juice, of the fragment of the soma plant (अंशोः (*aṃśoḥ*)), purified with the ten-fold filter, has not been poured out (परिषिक्तं (*pariṣiktaṃ*)), not cast in the houses. But by this sacrificer only praise is made.

The sentence continues from the previous block: only praise is made by this sacrificer. The rest of the block is grammatical, on पोचे॑य (*pocèya*)[?353], अतृणत् (*atṛṇat*) (with "milking is itself harming" noted), and परिषिक्तं (*pariṣiktaṃ*).

Word-to-word meaning

- शुशुचानं (*śuśucānaṃ*)—the shining one (O Agni)
- होतारं (*hotāraṃ*)—the caller of the gods
- विश्वभरसं (*viśvabharasaṃ*)—the nourisher of the whole world
- यजिष्ठं (*yajiṣṭhaṃ*)—the most worshipful
- अग्निं (*agniṃ*)—you, of the form of Agni
- अच्छ (*accha*)—directing myself to
- वोचेयु (*voceyu*)—I praise
- गवां (*gavāṃ*)—of the cows
- ऊधः (*ūdhaḥ*)—the udder (the milk)
- न अतृणं (*na atṛṇaṃ*)—was not milked
- अंशोः (*aṃśoḥ*)—of the soma
- अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*)—the food in the form of juice
- पूतं (*pūtaṃ*)—purified
- न परिषिक्तं (*na pariṣiktaṃ*)—was not placed in the house (may you be satisfied with praise alone)

Gist

O Agni, you who are shining, who call the gods to the sacrifice, nourisher of the whole world, the most worshipful, of the form of Agni: directing myself to you I offer praise. Because the sacrificer is poor, milk could not be milked and offered. The food in the form of soma juice could not be offered. Only praise has been recited.

English translation

May I glorify the present radiant Agni, the invoker (of the gods), the supporter of the universe, most deserving of adoration, without milking the pure udder (of thc cow), without the purified food of the Soma offered in libation.

Special Topics

In this Ṛk the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice is poor, and so has no power to offer milk, oblation or soma juice. Agni is therefore prayed to be satisfied with praises alone, accompanied by devotion and faith, which the sacrificer has offered.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि॒श्वे॑षा॒मदि॑तिर्य॒ज्ञिया॑नां॒ विश्वे॑षा॒मति॑थि॒र्मानु॑षाणाम् ।
अ॒ग्निर्दे॒वाना॒मव॑ आवृणा॒नः सु॑मृळी॒को भ॑वतु जा॒तवे॑दाः ॥ २० ॥

> *viśveṣāmaditiryajñiyānāṃ viśveṣāmatithirmānuṣāṇām |*
> *agnirdevānāmava āvṛṇānaḥ sumṛḷīko bhavatu jātavedāḥ ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विश्वेषां । अदितिः । यज्ञियानां । विश्वेषां । अतिथिः । मानुषाणां ।
> अग्निः । देवानां । अवः । आवृणानः । सुमृळीकः । भवतु । जातवेदाः ॥ २० ॥

> *viśveṣām | aditiḥ | yajñiyānām | viśveṣām | atithiḥ | mānuṣāṇām |*
> *agniḥ | devānām | avaḥ | āvṛṇānaḥ | sumṛḷīkaḥ | bhavatu | jātavedāḥ ‖*
> *20 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अयमग्निर्विश्वेषां सर्वेषां यज्ञियानां यज्ञाहर्णाणां देवानामदितिः
> अदितिर्देवमाता । तद्वद्देवानां पोषक इत्यर्थः । यद्वा । विश्वेषां देवानामदितिर्भूस्थानीयः
> आधारभूत इति यावत् । अयं वा अग्निर्वैश्वानर इति श्रुतेः ।
> तथायमग्निर्विश्वेषां मानुषाणामतिथिरतिथिवत्तूज्यो भवति । देवानां देवनशीलानां
> स्तोतृणामवोऽन्नं हनिरावृणानः संभजन् जातवेदाः । जातं सर्वं
> वेत्तीति जातवेदाः । सोऽग्निस्तेषां स्तोतृणां सुमृळीकः सुखकरो भवतु ॥
> अतिथिः । अत सातत्यगमने । ऋतन्यंजीत्यादिनेथिन्प्रत्ययः । नित्वादाद्युदात्तः ।
> मानुषाणां । मनोरपत्यानीत्यर्थे मनोर्जातावञ्यौ षुक्चेत्यि प्रत्ययः ।
> इत्त्वादाद्युदात्तः ॥

> *ayamagnirviśveṣāṃ sarvèṣāṃ yajñiyānāṃ yajñāharṇāṇāṃ*
> *devānāmaditiḥ*
> *aditirdevamātā | tadvaddevānāṃ poṣaka ityarthaḥ | yadvā | viśveṣāṃ*
> *devānāmaditirbhūsthānīyaḥ ādhārabhūta iti yāvat | ayaṃ vā*
> *agnirvaiśvānara iti śruteḥ |*
> *tathāyamagnirviśveṣāṃ mānuṣāṇāmatithiratithivattūjyo bhavati |*

> *devānāṃ devanaśīlānāṃ stotṛṇāmavo 'nnaṃ hanirāvṛṇānaḥ saṃbhajan jātavedāḥ | jātaṃ sarvaṃ*
> *vettīti jātavedāḥ | so 'gnisteṣāṃ stotṛṇāṃ sumṛḷīkaḥ sukhakaro bhavatu ‖*
> *atithiḥ | ata sātatyagamane | ṛtanyaṃjītyādinethinpratyayaḥ | nitvādādyudāttaḥ |*
> *mānuṣāṇāṃ | manorapatyānītyarthe manorjātāvañtyau ṣukcetyi pratyayaḥ |*
> *ittvādādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

This Agni is the अदितिः (*aditiḥ*) of all the gods who are worthy of sacrifice, who receive the sacrificial offerings. Aditi is the mother of the gods, so the meaning is that he nourishes the gods as she does. Alternatively, he is the Aditi of all the gods in the sense of the earth-like one, that is, their support. Sāyaṇa cites the Śruti अयं वा अग्निर्वैश्वानर इति (*ayaṃ vā agnirvaiśvānara iti*) for this. Likewise this Agni is the guest of all men and is to be honoured like a guest. He receives the food, that is, the oblation, of the gods, here the praisers (stotṛ), who are "of a shining nature". He is Jātavedas, because he knows everything that is born. May he be a bringer of comfort to those praisers.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- विश्वेषां (*viśveṣāṃ*)—of all
- यज्ञयानां (*yajñayānāṃ*)—of the gods worthy of sacrifice
- अदितिः (*aditiḥ*)—he is the divine mother (the nourisher)
- विश्वेषां (*viśveṣāṃ*)—of all
- मानुषाणां (*mānuṣāṇāṃ*)—of men
- अतिथिः (*atithiḥ*)—he is the guest
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—of the praisers
- अवः (*avaḥ*)—the food in the form of the oblation
- अवृणानः (*avṛṇānaḥ*)—accepting and partaking
- जातवेदाः (*jātavedāḥ*)—Agni, the all-knowing
- सुमृळीकः (*sumṛḷīkaḥ*)—as the giver of comfort to them

- भवतु (*bhavatu*)—may he be

Gist

Agni is the nourisher, like the divine mother, of all the gods who are worthy of sacrifice. He is the guest of all men. May the all-knowing Agni, accepting and partaking of the food in the form of the oblation offered by the praisers, be the giver of comfort to them.

English translation

May Agni be the Aditi of all those to whom sacrifice is offered ; may he be the guest of all men : receiving the (sacrificial) food of the devout' may he, to whom all is known, be the bestower of felicity.

Sūkta 2 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यो मर्त्येष्विति विंशत्यृचं द्वितीयं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभमाग्नेयं । यो मर्त्येष्वित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥
> अस्य सूक्तस्य प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोः पूर्वसूक्त एव विनियोग उक्तः ॥
> अनुवादवु—यो मर्त्येषु ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि ऎरडनॆय
> सूक्तवु– इदरल्लि इप्पत्तु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु
> देवतॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—यो मर्त्येषु ऎंदु मॊदलागि हेळिरु
> वुदु. प्रातरनुवाक मत्तु आश्विनशस्त्रमंत्रगळिगागि ई सूक्तद विनि योगविरुवुदॆंदु हिंदिन
> सूक्तद विनियोगक्रव दल्लिये हेळलागिदॆ
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त–२
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—२ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—१६, १७, १८, १९ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—२० ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—अग्निः ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *yo martyeṣṭiti viṃśatyṛcaṃ dvitīyaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhamāgneyaṃ | yo martyeṣṭityanukramaṇikā ‖ asya sūktasya prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayoḥ pūrvasūkta eva viniyoga uktaḥ ‖*
> *anuvādavu—yo martyeṣu èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèya anuvākadalli èraḍanèya*
> *sūktavu- idaralli ippattu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu*
> *devatèyu ; triṣṭup chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli—yo martyeṣu èṃdu mòdalāgi heḷiru*
> *vudu. prātaranuvāka mattu āśvinaśastramaṃtragaḷigāgi ī sūktada vini yogaviruvudèṃdu hiṃdina*
> *sūktada viniyogakrava dalliye heḷalāgidè*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta-2*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—2 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—16, 17, 18, 19 ‖*

> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—20 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agniḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The second sūkta, यो मर्त्येषु (*yo martyeṣu*), has twenty ṛcs. Its seer is Vāmadeva, its deity Agni, its metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā says: यो मर्त्येषु (*yo martyeṣu*). The use of this sūkta in the Prātaranuvāka and in the Āśvinaśastra has already been stated under the preceding sūkta. The block also gives the particulars: Maṇḍala 4, Anuvāka 1, Sūkta 2, Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 4, Vargas 16, 17, 18, 19, twenty ṛcs, seer Vāmadeva, deity Agni, metre Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यो मर्त्ये॑ष्व॒मृत॑ ऋ॒तावा॑ दे॒वो दे॒वेष्व॑र॒तिर्नि॒धायि॑ ।
होता॒ यजि॑ष्ठो म॒ह्ना शु॒चध्यै॑ ह॒व्यैर॒ग्निर्मनु॑ष ईर॒यध्यै॑
॥ १ ॥

> *yo martyeṣvamṛta ṛtāvā devo deveṣvaratirnidhāyi |*
> *hotā yajiṣṭho mahnā śucadhyai havyairagnirmanuṣa īrayadhyai ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । मर्त्येषु । अमृतः । ऋतवा । देवः । देवेषु । आरतिः । निधायि ।
> होता । यजिष्ठः । मह्ना । शुचध्यै । हव्यैः । अग्निः । मनुषः । ईरयध्यै ॥ १ ॥

> *yaḥ | martyeṣu | amṛtaḥ | ṛtavā | devaḥ | deveṣu | āratiḥ | nidhāyi |*
> *hotā | yajiṣṭhaḥ | mahnā | śucadhyai | havyaiḥ | agniḥ | manuṣaḥ |*
> *īrayadhyai ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अमृतो मरणधर्मरहितो योग्निर्मर्त्येषु मनुष्येष्टताना सत्यवान्निधायि निहितः । यद्वा । मर्त्येषु
> मनुष्यसंबंधिषु वागादींद्रियेषु निहितः ।
> अग्निर्वाग्भूत्वा मुखं प्राविशदिति श्रुतेः । देवो देवनशीलो योग्निरिंद्रादिषु
> देवेश्वरतिरभिगंता शत्रूणां । यद्वा । देवलोके गंता । निधायि निहितः । स च
> होता देवानामाह्वाता यजिष्ठो यश्वतमोग्निर्मह्ना स्वकीयेन महता
> तेजसा शुचध्यै दीपितुमुत्तरवेद्यां निहितः । किंच
> हव्यैर्हवनीय्यराज्यपुरोडाशादिभिर्हविर्भिर्हेतुभिर्मनुषो मनुष्यस्य यजमानस्येरयध्यै स्वर्ग० प्रति
> प्रेरणाय निहितः ॥ अरतिः । ऋ गतौ । वहिवस्यर्तिभ्यश्चिदित्यतिप्रत्ययः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः ।
> निधायि । दधातेः कर्मणि लुजु रूपं । परादिश्चंदसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । शुचध्यै । शुच दीप्तौ
> । तुमर्थे कथ्यै प्रत्ययः । कित्वादगुणः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । ईरयध्यै । ईरयतेस्तुमर्थे कथ्यै प्रत्ययः । शित्वेन
> सार्वधातुकत्वाण्णिलोपाभावः ॥

> *amṛto maraṇadharmarahito yognirmartyeṣu manuṣyeṣṭatānā*
> *satyavānnidhāyi nihitaḥ | yadvā | martyeṣu manuṣyasaṃbaṃdhiṣu*
> *vāgādīṃdriyeṣu nihitaḥ |*
> *agnirvāgbhūtvā mukhaṃ prāviśaditi śruteḥ | devo devanaśīlo*
> *yogniriṃdrādiṣu*
> *deveśvaratirabhigaṃtā śatrūṇāṃ | yadvā | devaloke gaṃtā | nidhāyi*
> *nihitaḥ | sa ca*
> *hotā devānāmāhvātā yajiṣṭho yaścatamognirmahnā svakīyena mahatā*
> *tejasā śucadhyai dīpitumuttaravedyāṃ nihitaḥ | kiṃca*
> *havyairhavanīyyarājyapuroḍāśādibhirhavirbhirhetubhirmanuṣo*
> *manuṣyasya yajamānasyèrayadhyai svargao prati*
> *preraṇāya nihitaḥ ‖ aratiḥ | ṛ gatau |*
> *vahivasyartibhyaściditYatipratyayaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ | nidhāyi |*
> *dadhāteḥ karmaṇi luju rūpaṃ |*
> *parādiścaṃdasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | śucadhyai | śuca dīptau |*
> *tumarthe kathyai pratyayaḥ | kitvādaguṇaḥ |*
> *pratyayasvaraḥ | īrayadhyai | īrayatestumarthe kathyai pratyayaḥ |*
> *śitvena sārvadhātukatvāṇṇilopābhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

Agni, who is immortal, free from the nature of dying, has been placed (निधायि (*nidhāyi*)) among mortals, men, as the one who is true and protects truth. Alternatively, he has been placed in the speech

and other organs belonging to men, for the Śruti says अग्निर्वाग्भूत्वा मुखं प्राविशदिति (*agnirvāgbhūtvā mukhaṃ prāviśaditi*). He is divine, of a shining nature, and among gods such as Indra he is अरतिः (*aratiḥ*), the one who goes against enemies; alternatively, one who goes to the world of the gods. He is the Hotṛ, the caller of the gods, and the most worshipful (यजिष्ठः (*yajiṣṭhaḥ*)). By his own great radiance he is placed on the northern altar (uttaravedi) in order to shine. Moreover, by means of oblations (हव्यैः (*havyaiḥ*)), the offerings fit for the fire such as ghee and cakes, he is placed to impel the man, the sacrificer, towards heaven.

Word-to-word meaning

- अमृतः (*amṛtaḥ*)—deathless
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Agni
- मर्त्येषु (*martyeṣu*)—among men
- ऋताना (*ṛtānā*)—as protector of truth[?354]
- निधायि (*nidhāyi*)—who has been placed, and
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—which Agni, divine in nature
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among the gods, Indra and others
- आरतिः (*āratiḥ*)—is established as destroyer of enemies
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—that same Agni
- होता (*hotā*)—as Hotṛ
- यजिष्ठः (*yajiṣṭhaḥ*)—as most worshipful
- मह्ना (*mahnā*)—with his own radiance
- शुचध्यै (*śucadhyai*)—is established on the shining northern altar
- हव्यैः (*havyaiḥ*)—with the help of the oblations
- मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)—of the sacrificer, the man
- ईरयध्यै (*īrayadhyai*)—is established also for his elevation

Gist

The Agni who is deathless and divine in nature, who is established among men as protector of truth and among the gods, Indra and the others, as destroyer of enemies, that same Agni, in the form of the Hotṛ and as the most worshipful, is established on the shining northern altar together with his radiance. With the help of the oblations he is established also for the elevation of the man, the sacrificer.

English translation

He who has been placed immortal among the mortals, the observer of truth, a diety triumphant among gods, the invoker of the gods, the most diligent sacrificer, Agni : he has been placed (upon the altar) to lighten (the ceremony) by. his (lustre), and for the elevation of the worshipper, through oblations (in heaven).

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒ह त्वं सू॑नो सहसो नो अ॒द्य जा॒तो जा॒ताँ उ॒भयाँ᳚ अ॒न्तर॑ग्ने ।
दू॒त ई॑यसे युयुजा॒न ऋ॑ष्व ऋजुमु॒ष्कान्वृष॑णः शु॒क्राँश्च॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *iha tvaṃ sūno sahaso no adya jāto jātā~ ubhayā~ antaragne |*
> *dūta īyase yuyujāna ṛṣva ṛjumuṣkānvṛṣaṇaḥ śukrā~śca ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ह । त्वं । सूनो इति । सहसः । नः । अद्य । जातः । जातान् । उभयान् । अंतः ।
> अग्ने ॥
> दूतः । ईयसे । युयुजानः । यष्ट । यजुमुष्कान् । वृषणः । शुक्रान् । च ।

> *ha | tvaṃ | sūno iti | sahasaḥ | naḥ | adya | jātaḥ | jātān | ubhayān | aṃtaḥ |*
> *agne ‖*
> *dūtaḥ | īyase | yuyujānaḥ | yaṣṭa | yajumuṣkān | vṛṣaṇaḥ | śukrān | ca |*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे सहसः सूनो बलस्य पुत्राग्ने अद्यास्मिन्दिवसे नोऽस्मदीय इह कर्मणि
> जात आधानपवमानेष्टिभिः संस्कृतस्त्वं जातानुत्पन्नानुभयान्देवमनुष्यानंतस्तेषामुभयेषां मध्ये॓
> दूतो हवींषि देवान्प्रापयितुमीयसे । गच्छसि । किं
> कुर्वन् । हे ऋष्व दर्शनीयाग्ने ऋजुमुष्कान् । मुष्कशब्देन मांसलोऽभिधीयते । ऋजवः
> प्रसाधकाः । ऋजुवश्च ते मुष्काश्चेत्यृजुमुष्काः । तान्वृषणः
> रेतःसेचनसमर्थान् शुक्रान्दीप्यमानानश्वांश्च युयुजानः स्वरथे योजयन्नीयसे । यद्वा । ऋष्व
> महन्नग्ने युयुजानो हविर्वहने नियुज्यमानस्त्वं
> वृषणो हविःसेचनसमर्थान्यजमानान् दीप्तान्देवांश्चेयसे ॥ सूनो सहसः ।
> परमपि छंदसीति सहसः परांगवद्भावात् द्वयोः सर्वानुदात्तत्वं । ईयसे ।
> ईज् गत् । दिवादिः । निघातः । युयुजानः । युजे॓ः वर्तमाने लिट कानचि
> रूपं । ऋष्व । संहितायामृत्यक इति प्रकृतिभावः । ऋजुमुष्कान् । समासस्वरः ॥

> *he sahasaḥ sūno balasya putrāgne adyāsmindivase no 'smadīya iha karmaṇi*
> *jāta ādhānapavamāneṣṭibhiḥ saṃskṛtastvaṃ jātānutpannānubhayāndevamanuṣyānaṃtasteṣāmubhayeṣāṃ madhyè*
> *dūto havīṃṣi devānprāpayitumīyase | gacchasi | kiṃ*
> *kurvan | he ṛṣva darśanīyāgne ṛjumuṣkān | muṣkaśabdena māṃsalo 'bhidhīyate | ṛjavaḥ prasādhakāḥ | ṛjuvaśca te muṣkāścetyṛjumuṣkāḥ | tānvṛṣaṇaḥ*
> *retaḥsecanasamarthān śukrāndīpyamānānaśvāṃśca yuyujānaḥ svarathe yojayannīyase | yadvā | ṛṣva mahannagne yuyujāno havirvahane niyujyamānastvaṃ*
> *vṛṣaṇo haviḥsecanasamarthānyajamānān dīptāndevāṃśceyase ‖ sūno sahasaḥ |*
> *paramapi chaṃdasīti sahasaḥ parāṃgavadbhāvāt dvayoḥ sarvānudāttatvaṃ | īyase |*
> *īj gat | divādiḥ | nighātaḥ | yuyujānaḥ | yujèḥ vartamāne liṭa kānaci*
> *rūpaṃ | ṛṣva | saṃhitāyāmṛtyaka iti prakṛtibhāvaḥ | ṛjumuṣkān | samāsasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, son of strength (सहसः सूनो (*sahasaḥ sūno*))! Today, in this our rite, you who have been born, that is, refined by the Ādhāna and the Pavamāneṣṭis, go (ईयसे (*īyase*)) as messenger among both the born, gods and men, to convey the oblations to the gods. What do you do as you go? O Ṛṣva, graceful Agni, you go yoking to your chariot the horses that are ऋजुमुष्कान् (*ṛjumuṣkān*). The word मुष्क (*muṣka*) denotes "fleshy"; ऋजवः (*ṛjavaḥ*) are "adorning"; so ऋजुमुष्कान् (*ṛjumuṣkān*) are those that are both adorning and fleshy. They are वृषणः (*vṛṣaṇaḥ*), able to shed seed, and शुक्रान् (*śukrān*), shining. Alternatively: O great Agni, appointed to carry the oblation, you go to the sacrificers who are able to pour out the oblation and to the shining gods.

Word-to-word meaning

- सहसः सूनो (*sahasaḥ sūno*)—O son of strength
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- आद्य (*ādya*)—today
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- इह (*iha*)—in this time of the rite
- जातः (*jātaḥ*)—well refined
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- जातान् (*jātān*)—of the born
- उभयान् (*ubhayān*)—both, gods and men
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the midst
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—as messenger of the gods
- ईयेसे (*īyèse*)—you are ready (to carry the oblation)
- ऋष्प (*ṛṣpa*)—O graceful Agni[?355]
- यजुमुष्कान् (*yajumuṣkān*)—those that are robust and adorned[?356]
- वृष्टि (*vṛṣṭi*)—those that are able to shed seed[?357]
- शुक्रान् (*śukrān*)—and shining, your horses
- युयुजानः (*yuyujānaḥ*)—you are ready to harness to the chariot

Gist

O Agni, son of strength, today, at the time of this our rite, you, well refined, are ready, as messenger of the gods, to carry the oblation even in the midst of all the gods and men who have been born. O graceful Agni, you are ready, having harnessed to the chariot your horses that are robust, adorned, powerful and shining.

English translation

Agni, son of strength, generated to-day at this our rite, as intermediate between both (gods and men) you proceed, the invoker (of the gods), harnessiug, graceful Agni, your robust, vigorous, and resplendent steeds.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अत्या॑ वृ॒धस्नू रोहि॑ता घृ॒तस्नू॑ ऋ॒तस्य॑ मन्ये॒ मन॑सा॒ जवि॑ष्ठा ।
अ॒न्तरी॑यसे अरु॒षा यु॑जा॒नो यु॒ष्माँश्च॑ दे॒वान्विश॒ आ च॒ मर्ता॑न् ॥ ३ ॥

> *atyā vṛdhasnū rohitā ghṛtasnū ṛtasya manye manasā javiṣṭhā |*
> *antarīyase aruṣā yujāno yuṣmā~śca devānviśa ā ca martān ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अत्या । वृधस्नू इति वृध्सनू । रोहिता । घृतस्नू इति घृतस्नू । ऋतस्य । मन्ये ।
> मनसा । जविष्ठा ।
> अंतः । ईयसे । अरुषा । युजानः । युष्मान् । च । देवान् । विशः । आ । च ।
> ।
> मर्तान् ॥ ३ ॥

> *atyā | vṛdhasnū iti vṛdhsanū | rohitā | ghṛtasnū iti ghṛtasnū | ṛtasya |*
> *manye |*
> *manasā | javiṣṭhā |*
> *aṃtaḥ | īyase | aruṣā | yujānaḥ | yuṣmān | ca | devān | viśaḥ | ā | ca |*
> *|*
> *martān ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ऋतस्य सत्यभूतस्य तव संबंधिनौ मनसा मनसोऽपि जविष्ठा वेगवत्तमौ वृधस्नू ।
> वर्धयतीति वृधमन्नं । तत्क्षरंतौ । धृतस्नू । धृतमुदकं
> तत्स्ववंतौ रोहिता रोहितवर्णावित्पाश्वा मन्ये । स्वामि । अरुषारोचमाना
> तावश्च युजानो रथे युंजानस्त्वं युष्मान् । देवेश्वगेरंतर्भावाद्यजनीयरूपेण कीर्तनं ।
> युष्मान्यष्टव्यान्देवान् विशः परिचारकान्मर्तान्मनुष्यानंतः ।
> षष्ठ्यर्थे द्वितीया । तेषां मध्य आ समंतादीयसे । हविः स्वीकर्तुं यजमानान् गच्छसि ।
> तद्धविः प्रदातुं देवान् गच्छसि ॥ मन्ये । मन्यतिरर्चतिकर्मा ।
> मनसा । सुपां सुलुगिति पंचम्या आकारः । युजानः । युजिर् योगे । युजिबुधिदृशः
> किच्चेत्यानच् प्रत्ययः । चित्वादंतोदात्तः ॥

> *he agne ṛtasya satyabhūtasya tava saṃbaṃdhinau manasā manaso 'pi javiṣṭhā vegavattamau vṛdhasnū | vardhayatīti vṛdhamannaṃ |*
> *tatkṣaraṃtau | dhṛtasnū | dhṛtamudakaṃ*
> *tatsvavaṃtau rohitā rohitavarṇāvatpāśvā manye | svāmi |*
> *aruṣārocamānā*
> *tāvaśca yujāno rathe yuṃjānastvaṃ yuṣmān |*
> *deveśvageraṃtarbhāvādyajanīyarūpeṇa kīrtanaṃ |*
> *yuṣmānyaṣṭavyāndevān viśaḥ paricārakānmartānmanuṣyānaṃtaḥ |*
> *ṣaṣṭhyarthe dvitīyā | teṣāṃ madhya ā samaṃtādīyase | haviḥ svīkartuṃ yajamānān gacchasi | taddhaviḥ pradātuṃ devān gacchasi ‖ manye |*
> *manyatirarcatikarmā |*
> *manasā | supāṃ sulugiti paṃcamyā ākāraḥ | yujānaḥ | yujir yoge |*
> *yujibudhidṛśaḥ kiccetyānac pratyayaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you who are true (ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)): the two horses belonging to you, swifter than the mind and the swiftest, are वृधस्नू (*vṛdhasnū*). वृध (*vṛdha*) is the food that makes grow; they let it flow. They are धृतस्नू (*dhṛtasnū*): धृत (*dhṛta*) is water, and they possess it. I think of them as रोहिता (*rohitā*), of reddish colour, and horses.[?358] You yoke to the chariot those shining (अरुषा (*aruṣā*)) horses. The word युष्मान् (*yuṣmān*) (you, the gods): because the gods are included among the horses, they are mentioned here in a form worthy of worship.[?359] युष्मान् (*yuṣmān*) are the gods to be worshipped; विशः (*viśaḥ*) are the attendants, mortal men. The accusative अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*) stands in the sense of the genitive. You go all around (ईयसे (*īyase*)) in the midst of them: you go to the sacrificers to accept the oblation, and to the gods to give them that oblation. मन्ये (*manye*) is a verb meaning "to worship". The remainder of the block is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—belonging to you, who are true in nature
- मनसा (*manasā*)—than the speed of the mind
- जविष्ठा (*javiṣṭhā*)—those that are swift
- वृधस्नू (*vṛdhasnū*)—those that pour out food
- घतस्नू (*ghatasnū*)—those that rain water[?360]
- रोहिता (*rohitā*)—of reddish colour
- अत्या (*atyā*)—the horses
- मन्ये (*manye*)—I praise
- अरुषा (*aruṣā*)—those radiant horses
- युजानः (*yujānaḥ*)—you who have yoked to the chariot
- युष्मान् (*yuṣmān*)—
- *yuṣmān*—(you,) venerable among you
- देवान् (*devān*)—the gods
- विशः (*viśaḥ*)—the people who worship you
- मर्तान् (*martān*)—human beings
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in between
- आ (*ā*)—all around
- ईयसे (*īyase*)—you go to receive and distribute the oblation

Gist

O Agni, I praise the horses that belong to you, whose nature is truth, which travel faster than the mind, which pour forth food and water, and which are of ruddy colour. Having yoked the radiant horses to the chariot, you go about, in between and all around, to receive the oblation and distribute it, among the gods who are venerable among you and the human beings who worship you.

English translation

I celebrate the ruddy, food-bestowing, water-shedding, and swifter-than-thought-going, steads of him who is the truth : harnessing the brilliant pair (to your chariot), you pass between the deities and human wor- shippers.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒र्य॒मणं॒ वरु॑णं मि॒त्रमे॑षा॒मिन्द्रा॒विष्णू॑ म॒रुतो॑ अ॒श्विनो॒त ।
स्वश्वो॑ अग्ने सु॒रथ॑ः सु॒राधा॒ एदु॑ वह सुह॒विषे॒ जना॑य ॥ ४ ॥

> *aryamaṇaṃ varuṇaṃ mitrameṣāmindrāviṣṇū maruto aśvinota |*
> *svaśvo agne surathaḥ surādhā edu vaha suhaviṣe janāya ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अर्यमणं । वरुणं । मित्रं । एषां । इंद्राविष्णू इति । मरुतः । अश्विना । उत ।
> सुअश्वः । अग्ने । सुरथः । सुराधाः । आ । इत् । ऊं इति । वह । सुहविषे ।
> जनाय ॥ ४ ॥

> *aryamaṇaṃ | varuṇaṃ | mitraṃ | eṣāṃ | iṃdrāviṣṇū iti | marutaḥ | aśvinā | uta |*
> *suaśvaḥ | agne | surathaḥ | surādhāḥ | ā | it | ūṃ iti | vaha | suhaviṣe |*
> *janāya ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने स्वश्वः शोभनाश्वोपेतः सुरथः शोभनरथः सुराधाः शोभनधनोपेतस्त्वमेषां मर्त्यानां मध्ये सुहविषे शोभनहविष्काय जनाय यज–

> *he agne svaśvaḥ śobhanāśvopetaḥ surathaḥ śobhanarathaḥ surādhāḥ*
> *śobhanadhanopetastvameṣāṃ martyānāṃ madhyè suhaviṣe*
> *śobhanahaviṣkāya janāya yaja-*

> मानायार्यमादीनुतापि चाश्विन् यष्टव्यान्देवाना वहेदु । आह्वयैव । उः
> पूरणः ॥ इंद्राविष्णु । ऋज्रेंद्रेत्यादिना निपातनादिंद्रशब्द आद्युदात्तः । देवताद्वंद्व
> चेत्युभयपदप्रकृतिस्वरत्वं। सुहविषे । नञ्सुभ्यामित्युत्तरपदांतोदात्तत्वं॥

> *mānāyāryamādīnutāpi cāśvin yaṣṭavyāndevānā vahedu | āhvayaiva | uḥ*
> *pūraṇaḥ || iṃdrāviṣṇu | ṛjreṃdretyādinā nipātanādiṃdraśabda*
> *ādyudāttaḥ | devatādvaṃdva cetyubhayapadaprakṛtisvaratvaṃ|*
> *suhaviṣe | nañsubhyāmityuttarapadāṃtodāttatvaṃ||*

Summary

"O Agni, you who are स्वश्वः (*svaśvaḥ*), furnished with good horses, सुरथः (*surathaḥ*), having a good chariot, and सुराधाः (*surādhāḥ*), possessed of good wealth: among these mortals, for the man, the sacrificer, who has good oblations, bring Aryaman and the others, and also the Aśvins, the gods who are to be worshipped..." (the sentence continues in the next block).

The sentence is completed: वहेदु (*vahedu*) means "call and bring"; उः (*uḥ*) is a filler particle. The rest of the block gives the accent of इंद्राविष्णू (*iṃdrāviṣṇū*) and सुहविषे (*suhaviṣe*), which is grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- स्वश्वः (*svaśvaḥ*)—you who are furnished with an excellent horse
- सुरथः (*surathaḥ*)—having an excellent chariot
- सुराधाः (*surādhāḥ*)—possessing excellent wealth, you
- एषां (*eṣāṃ*)—among these human beings
- सुहविषे (*suhaviṣe*)—for the sacrificer who has an excellent oblation
- जनाय (*janāya*)—for the man
- अरमणं (*aramaṇaṃ*)—the god Aryaman[?361]
- वरुणं (*varuṇaṃ*)—Varuṇa
- मित्रं (*mitraṃ*)—Mitra
- इंद्राविष्णु (*iṃdrāviṣṇu*)—Indra and Viṣṇu

- मरुतः (*marutaḥ*)—the Maruts
- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—the Aśvin deities
- आ वह इत् (*ā vaha it*)—surely bring them

Gist

O Agni, you who are furnished with an excellent horse, have an excellent chariot and possess excellent wealth: among these human beings, bring for the sacrificer who has an excellent oblation Aryaman, Varuṇa, Mitra, Indra and Viṣṇu, the Maruts and the deities called Aśvins.?362

English translation

Possessed, Agni, of good steeds, an excellent car, and abundant wealth do you, amidst these (worshippers) bring to the man who offers worthy oblations, Aryaman, Varuna, Mitra, Vishnu, the Maruts, or the Ashwins,

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

गोमाँ अ॒ग्नेऽवि॑माँ अ॒श्वी य॒ज्ञो नृ॒वत्स॑खा॒ सद॒मिद॑प्रमृ॒
ष्यः ।
इळा॑वाँ ए॒षो अ॑सुर प्र॒जावा॑न्दी॒र्घो र॒यिः पृ॑थुबु॒ध्नः
स॒भावा॑न् ॥ ५ ॥

> *gomā~ agne 'vimā~ aśvī yajño nṛvatsakhā sadamidapramṛṣyaḥ |*
> *iḷāvā~ eṣo asura prajāvāndīrgho rayiḥ pṛthubudhnaḥ sabhāvān ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गोऽमान् । अग्ने । अविऽमान् । आश्वी । यज्ञः । नृवत्ऽसखा । सदं । इत् । अप्रऽमृष्यः ।
> इळावान् । एषः । असुर । प्रजावान् । दीर्घः । रयिः । पृथुबुध्नः । सभावान् ॥

> *go 'mān | agne | avi 'mān | āśvī | yajñaḥ | nṛvat 'sakhā | sadaṃ | it | apra 'mṛṣyaḥ |*
> *iḷāvān | eṣaḥ | asura | prajāvān | dīrghaḥ | rayiḥ | pṛthubudhnaḥ | sabhāvān ||*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे असुर बलवन्ने अग्ने एष मदीयोऽयं यज्ञो गोमान् गोभिस्तद्वानविमान् । अवयो मेषा अस्य संति तद्वान् अश्वश्वोपेतश्चास्तु । नृवत्सखा ।
> नरः कर्मणां नेतारोऽध्वय्यादयस्तद्वंतः सखायोऽनुष्ठातारो यजमाना
> यस्य स तथोक्तः । सदमित्सदैवाप्रमृष्योऽप्रधृश्यश्चास्तु । तथेळावान् । इळा
> हनिर्लक्षणमन्नं तद्वान् । प्रजावान्पुत्रपौत्रादियुक्तश्चास्तु । दीर्घोऽविच्छिन्नानुष्ठानोपेतो
> रयिर्धनवान् । लुप्तमत्वर्तियः । पृथुबुद्धः । पृथूनि बहुलानि बुध्यानि धनादीनि कारणानि
> यस्य स तथोक्तः । सभावानुपद्रष्टरूपसभायुक्तश्चास्तु ॥ नृवत्सखा । नरो येषां संतीति नृवत्
> । मतुप् । तस्य छांदसं वत्वं।
> ह्रस्वनुड्छ्यां मतुबिति मतुप उदात्तत्वं । बहुव्रीहौ पूर्वपदस्वरः ॥

> *he asura balavanne agne eṣa madīyo 'yaṃ yajño gomān gobhistadvānavimān | avayo meṣā asya saṃti tadvān aśvaśvopetaścāstu | nṛvatsakhā |*
> *naraḥ karmaṇāṃ netāro 'dhvayyādayastadvaṃtaḥ sakhāyo 'nuṣṭhātāro yajamānā*
> *yasya sa tathoktaḥ | sadamitsadaivāpramṛṣyo 'pradhṛśyaścāstu | tatheḷāvān | iḷā*
> *hanirlakṣaṇamannaṃ tadvān | prajāvānputrapautrādiyuktaścāstu | dīrgho 'vicchinnānuṣṭhānopeto rayirdhanavān | luptamatvartiyaḥ | pṛthubuddhaḥ | pṛthūni bahulāni budhyāni dhanādīni kāraṇāni yasya sa tathoktaḥ | sabhāvānupadraṣṭarūpasabhāyuktaścāstu || nṛvatsakhā | naro yeṣāṃ saṃtīti nṛvat | matup | tasya chāṃdasaṃ vatvaṃ|*
> *hrasvanuḍchyāṃ matubiti matupa udāttatvaṃ | bahuvrīhau pūrvapadasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"O mighty Agni, this sacrifice of mine: let it be गोमान् (*gomān*), possessed of cows; अविमान् (*avimān*), possessed of *avayaḥ*, that is, rams (मेषा (*meṣā*)); and let it be furnished with horses. नृवत्सखा (*nṛvatsakhā*): the नरः (*naraḥ*) are the leaders of the rites, the adhvaryu and the others; those who have them as friends are the performers, the sacrificers; one whose sacrifice is such is so called. May it always be अप्रमृष्यः (*apramṛṣyaḥ*), not to be assailed. And इळावान् (*iḷāvān*): इळा (*iḷā*) is food in the form of the oblation, and it possesses that; प्रजावान् (*prajāvān*): let it be endowed with sons, grandsons and so on. दीर्घः (*dīrghaḥ*): attended by uninterrupted performance. रयिः (*rayiḥ*): wealthy. पृथुबुद्धः (*pṛthubuddhaḥ*): that of which the causes, wealth and the rest, are many and abundant. सभावान् (*sabhāvān*): let it be furnished with an assembly of onlookers." The rest is grammar (नृवत्सखा (*nṛvatsakhā*), the suffix, accents).[?363]

Word-to-word meaning

- असुर (*asura*)—O powerful one
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- एषः (*eṣaḥ*)—this sacrifice now being performed
- यज्ञः (*yajñaḥ*)—sacrifice
- गोमान् (*gomān*)—may it be possessed of cows
- अविमान् (*avimān*)—possessed of goats
- अश्वी (*aśvī*)—and furnished with horses
- नृसखा (*nṛsakhā*)—this sacrifice, joined with excellent sacrificers
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—always
- अप्रमृष्यः (*apramṛṣyaḥ*)—may it be unharmed
- इळावान् (*iḷāvān*)—endowed with food
- प्रजावान् (*prajāvān*)—joined with sons, grandsons and so on
- दीर्घः (*dīrghaḥ*)—continuing without interruption
- रयिः (*rayiḥ*)—endowed with wealth
- पृथुबुध्नः (*pṛthubudhnaḥ*)—having extensive basic wealth
- सभावान् (*sabhāvān*)—may it have an excellent assembly

Gist

O powerful Agni, may the sacrifice now being performed be possessed of cows, of goats and of horses. May this sacrifice, joined with excellent sacrificers, be always unharmed, endowed with food, joined with sons, grandsons and so on, continuing without obstruction, endowed with wealth, having extensive basic wealth, and attended by an excellent assembly.

English translation

May the sacrifice, Agni, be productive of cows, of sheep, of horses, and celebrated, by your worshipper, aided by the priests,be ever uninterrupted; may it, mighty Agni, be productive of food and progeny, long continued, affluent, wide based, and held in full assembly.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्ते॑ इ॒ध्मं ज॒भर॑त्सिष्विदा॒नो मू॒र्धानं॑ वा त॒तप॑ते त्वा॒या ।
भुव॒स्तस्य॒ स्वत॑वाँः पा॒युर॑ग्ने॒ विश्व॑स्मात्सीमघाय॒त उ॑रुष्य ॥ ६ ॥

> *yasta idhmaṃ jabharatsiṣvidāno mūrdhānaṃ vā tatapate tvāyā |*
> *bhuvastasya svatavā~ḥ pāyuragne viśvasmātsīmaghāyata uruṣya ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । ते । इध्मं । जभरत् । सिस्विदानः । मूर्धानं । वा । ततपते । त्वाया ।
> भुवः । तस्य । स्वतवान् । पायुः । अग्ने । विश्वस्मात् । सीम् । अघयतः । उरुष्य॥

> *yaḥ | te | idhmaṃ | jabharat | sisvidānaḥ | mūrdhānaṃ | vā | tatapate | tvāyā |*
> *bhuvaḥ | tasya | svatavān | pāyuḥ | agne | viśvasmāt | sīm | aghayataḥ | uruṣya‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ते त्वदर्थं यः पुमान् सिष्टिदानः सिस्विदानः स्विद्यद्गात्रः सन् इध्मं त्वत्समिंधनार्थं काष्ठभारं जभरत् । आहरति । यो वा त्वाया त्वत्कामनया मूर्धानं स्वमस्तकं ततपते काष्ठभारेण तापयति तस्य तादृशस्य पुंसः स्वतवान् । स्वतवान्थनवानिति तलवकार उक्तं । धनवान् भुवः । भवसि । पायुः पालयितासि । सीमेनं विश्वस्मादघायतोऽघं पापमिच्छतः पुरुषादुरुष्य । रक्ष॥ जभरत्। हरतेर्लुजि चजु रूपं । चज्यन्यतरस्यामिति चज्पूर्वस्कोदात्तत्वं । सिस्विदानः । इष्टिदा

> गात्रक्षरणे । कानचि रूपं । संहितायामादेशप्रत्यययोरिति धातुसकारस्य षत्वं ।
> त्वाया । त्वामात्मन इच्छतीत्यर्थे क्यच् । प्रत्ययोत्तरपदयोश्चेति मपर्यंतस्य
> त्वादेशः । दकारस्य छांदसमात्वं । क्यजंताद्धातोर्भावे आ प्रत्ययादित्यकारप्रत्ययः । सुपां सुलुगिति तृतीयाया आकारः । एकादेशस्वरः । भुवः । भवतेर्लेट्यडागमे रूपं ' भूसुवोस्ति जीति गुणप्रतिषेधः । आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वे धातु–

> *he agne te tvadarthaṃ yaḥ pumān siṣṭidānaḥ sisvidānaḥ svidyadgātraḥ san idhmaṃ*
> *tvatsamiṃdhanārthaṃ kāṣṭhabhāraṃ jabharat | āharati | yo vā tvāyā tvatkāmanayā*
> *mūrdhānaṃ svamastakaṃ tatapate kāṣṭhabhāreṇa tāpayati tasya tādṛśasya puṃsaḥ svatavān |*
> *svatavānthanavāniti talavakāra uktaṃ | dhanavān bhuvaḥ | bhavasi | pāyuḥ pālayitāsi |*
> *sīmenaṃ viśvasmādaghāyato 'ghaṃ pāpamicchataḥ puruṣāduruṣya | rakṣa‖ jabharat| haraterluji caju rūpaṃ | cajyanyatarasyāmiti cajpūrvaskodāttatvaṃ | sisvidānaḥ | iṣṭidā*
> *gātrakṣaraṇe | kānaci rūpaṃ | saṃhitāyāmādeśapratyayayoriti dhātusakārasya ṣatvaṃ |*
> *tvāyā | tvāmātmana icchatītyarthe kyac | pratyayottarapadayośceti maparyaṃtasya*
> *tvādeśaḥ | dakārasya chāṃdasamātvaṃ | kyajaṃtāddātorbhāve ā pratyayādityakārapratyayaḥ | supāṃ sulugiti tṛtīyāyā ākāraḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ | bhuvaḥ | bhavaterleṭyaḍāgame rūpaṃ ' bhūsuvosti jīti guṇapratiṣedhaḥ | āgamasyānudāttatve dhātu-*

> स्वरः । स्वतनाः पायुरित्यत्र संहितायां स्वतवान्पायौ । पा. ८–३–११ । इति नकारस्य
> रुत्वं । अत्रानुनासिकः पूर्वस्य तु वेत्याकारोऽनुनासिकः । रेफस्य विसर्जनीयः ।
> कुप्रोः कः पौ चेतिः स इत्यादेशः । अघायतः । अघमात्मन इच्छतीत्यर्थे
> सुपः क्यच् । अश्वाघस्यादित्यात्वं । तदंताच्चतृप्रत्ययः शतुरनुम इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ।
> उरुष्य । उरुशब्दः कंड्वादिः । लोटि रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *svaraḥ | svatanāḥ pāyurityatra saṃhitāyāṃ svatavānpāyau | pā. 8-3-11 | iti nakārasya*
> *rutvaṃ | atrānunāsikaḥ pūrvasya tu vetyākāro 'nunāsikaḥ | rephasya visarjanīyaḥ |*
> *kuproḥ kaḥ pau cetiḥ sa ityādeśaḥ | aghāyataḥ | aghamātmana icchatītyarthe*

> *supaḥ kyac | aśvāghasyādityātvaṃ | tadaṃtāccatṛpratyayaḥ śaturanuma iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | uruṣya | uruśabdaḥ kaṃḍvādiḥ | loṭi rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Agni, the man who, for you, being सिष्टिदानः (*siṣṭidānaḥ*) (सिस्विदानः (*sisvidānaḥ*)), his body dripping with sweat, brings (जभरत् (*jabharat*)) a load of wood for your kindling; or who, from desire for you (त्वाया (*tvāyā*)), heats his own head (मूर्धानं (*mūrdhānaṃ*)) with the load of wood: of such a man you become स्वतवान् (*svatavān*) (it is said that स्वतवान् (*svatavān*) means wealthy); you are पायुः (*pāyuḥ*), the protector. Protect (उरुष्य (*uruṣya*)) him from every man who desires harm, that is, evil." The rest of the block is grammar (जभरत् (*jabharat*), सिस्विदानः (*sisvidānaḥ*), त्वाया (*tvāyā*), भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*) and so on).

The block continues the grammar of स्वतवान्पायुः (*svatavānpāyuḥ*), अघायतः (*aghāyataḥ*) and उरुष्य (*uruṣya*).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ते (*te*)—for your worship
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- सिष्टिदानः (*siṣṭidānaḥ*)—pouring out sweat
- इध्मं (*idhmaṃ*)—sacrificial fuel
- जभरत् (*jabharat*)—brings
- ना (*nā*)—or whoever
- त्वाया (*tvāyā*)—looking for your favour
- मूर्धानं (*mūrdhānaṃ*)—his own head
- ततपते (*tatapate*)—burdens, carrying wood
- तस्य (*tasya*)—for the benefit of such a man
- स्वतवान् (*svatavān*)—wealthy
- भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*)—you become
- पायुः (*pāyuḥ*)—you become his protector
- सीं (*sīṃ*)—that man
- विश्वस्मात् (*viśvasmāt*)—from all
- अघायतः (*aghāyataḥ*)—sinners

- उरुष्य (*uruṣya*)—protect

Gist

O Agni, for the benefit of the man who, for your worship, brings sacrificial fuel while pouring out sweat and burdening his head, be wealthy, and, being his protector, protect him from all sinners who wish him harm.

English translation

You are the munificent recompenser of that man who, sweating (with toil), brings you fuel, and for your service causes his head to ache: protcet him, Agni, from every one that seeks to do him evil.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्ते॒ भरा॒दन्नि॑यते चि॒दन्नं॑ नि॒शिष॑न्म॒न्द्रमति॑थिमु॒दीर॑त् ।
आ दे॑व॒युरि॒नध॑ते दुरो॒णे तस्मि॑न्र॒यिर्ध्रु॒वो अ॑स्तु॒ दास्वा॑न् ॥ ७ ॥

> *yaste bharādanniyate cidannaṃ niśiṣanmandramatithimudīrat |*
> *ā devayurinadhate duroṇe tasminrayirdhruvo astu dāsvān ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । ते । भरात् । अन्नियते । चित् । अन्नं । निशिषत् । मंद्रं । अतिथिं । उत्ईरत् ।
> आ । देवयुः । इनधते । दुरोणे । तस्मिन् । रयिः । ध्रुवः । अस्तु । दास्वान् ॥ ७ ॥

> *yaḥ | te | bharāt | anniyate | cit | annaṃ | niśiṣat | maṃdraṃ | atithiṃ | utīrat |*
> *ā | devayuḥ | inadhate | duroṇe | tasmin | rayiḥ | dhruvaḥ | astu | dāsvān ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यः पुमानन्नियतेऽन्नमिच्छते ते तुभ्यं हविर्लक्षणं पुरोडाशादिकमन्नं भरात् दातुं बिभृयात् । चिदिति चार्थे । यश्च मंद्रं मदकरं
> सोमं निशिषत् नितरां प्रयच्छति । यश्चातिथिमतिथिवत्तूज्यं त्वामुदीरत् उत्तरवेद्यां प्रणयति । आ अपि च यश्च देवयुर्देवं त्वां कामयमानो दुरोणे
> स्वकीये गृह इनधते त्वां समिद्धिः समिंधते तस्मिन्नेतस्मिन्पुरुषे रयिः पुत्रो ध्रुव
> आस्तिक्यबुद्धा वैदिके मार्गे निश्चलोऽस्तु । तथा दास्वानौदार्योपेतश्चास्तु ॥
> भरात् । डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्य लेट्याडागमे रूपं। यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । अन्नियते । अन्नमात्मन इच्छते । क्यच् । क्यचि चेतीत्वं । ह्रस्वश्कांदसः ।
> निशिषत् । शासु अनुशिष्टौ । लुजु सर्तिशास्त्रर्तिभ्यश्चेति जेरजादेशः । शास इदङ्हलोरितीत्वं । उदीरत् । ईर गतौ । लेटि व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं । अडागमः ।
> आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । तिजु चोदात्तवतीति गतेर्निघातः । इनधते ।
> इइंधी दीप्तौ । लटि व्यत्ययेन शप् । रुधादित्वात् श्नम् । श्नान्नलोप इति धातुनकारलोपः
> क्वित्परत्वाभावात् श्नसोरल्लोपाभावः । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ।
> श्नमः स्वरः । दास्वान् । दास्य दाने । संपदादिलक्षणो भावे क्विप् । तदस्यास्तीति
> मतुप् । मादुपधाया इति वत्वं । प्रत्ययस्य पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he agne yaḥ pumānanniyate 'nnamicchate te tubhyaṃ havirlakṣaṇaṃ puroḍāśādikamannaṃ bharāt dātuṃ bibhṛyāt | ciditi cārthe | yaśca maṃdraṃ madakaraṃ*
> *somaṃ niśiṣat nitarāṃ prayacchati | yaścātithimatithivattūjyaṃ tvāmudīrat uttaravedyāṃ praṇayati | ā api ca yaśca devayurdevaṃ tvāṃ kāmayamāno duroṇe*
> *svakīye gṛha inadhate tvāṃ samiddhiḥ samiṃdhate tasminnetasminpuruṣe rayiḥ putro dhruva*
> *āstikyabuddhā vaidike mārge niścalo 'stu | tathā dāsvānaudāryopetaścāstu ‖*
> *bharāt | ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasya leṭyāḍāgame rūpaṃ| yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | anniyate | annamātmana icchate | kyac | kcaci cetītvaṃ | hrasvaśkāṃdasaḥ |*
> *niśiṣat | śāsu anuśiṣṭau | luju sartiśāstrartibhyaśceti jerajādeśaḥ | śāsa idaṅhaloritītvaṃ | udīrat | īra gatau | leṭi vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ | aḍāgamaḥ |*
> *āgamasyānudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | tiju codāttavatīti gaternighātaḥ | inadhate |*
> *iiṃdhī dīptau | laṭi vyatyayena śap | rudhāditvāt śnam | śnānnalopa iti*

> *dhātunakāralopaḥ kcitparatvābhāvāt śnasorallopābhāvaḥ |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *śnamaḥ svaraḥ | dāsvān | dāsya dāne | saṃpadādilakṣaṇo bhāve kvip |*
> *tadasyāstīti*
> *matup | mādupadhāyā iti vatvaṃ | pratyayasya pittvādanudāttatve*
> *dhātusvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"O Agni, the man who, to you who desire food (अन्नियते (*anniyate*)), would bring (भरात् (*bharāt*)), that is, would carry in order to give, food in the form of the oblation, the puroḍāśa and the rest; चित् (*cit*) is in the sense of 'and'. And he who offers (निशिषत् (*niśiṣat*)) continually the exhilarating Soma; and who brings forth (उदीरत् (*udīrat*)) on the uttaravedi you, to be honoured like a guest; and, moreover, who, desiring you, the god (देवयुः (*devayuḥ*)), kindles you with fuel in his own house (दुरोणे (*duroṇe*)): in that man let रयिः (*rayiḥ*), the son, be ध्रुवः (*dhruvaḥ*), firm on the Vedic path through belief; and let him be दास्वान् (*dāsvān*), endowed with generosity." The rest of the block is grammar (भरात् (*bharāt*), अन्नियते (*anniyate*), निशिषत् (*niśiṣat*), उदीरत् (*udīrat*), इनधते (*inadhate*), दास्वान् (*dāsvān*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the sacrificer who
- अन्नि यते (*anni yate*)—to you who desire food in the form of the oblation
- ते (*te*)—to you
- अन्नं (*annaṃ*)—food such as the puroḍāśa
- भरात् (*bharāt*)—offers
- चित् (*cit*)—and
- मंद्रं (*maṃdraṃ*)—agreeable Soma
- निशिषत् (*niśiṣat*)—offers (the one who)
- अतिथिं (*atithiṃ*)—you, the venerable one
- उदीरत् (*udīrat*)—establishes on the uttaravedi
- आ (*ā*)—and
- देवयुः (*devayuḥ*)—looking for the favour of you, who are divine

- दुरोणे (*duroṇe*)—in his own sacrificial house
- इनधते (*inadhate*)—causes you to blaze
- तस्मिन् (*tasmin*)—of such a man
- रयिः (*rayiḥ*)—the son
- ध्रुवः अस्तु (*dhruvaḥ astu*)—let him be a firm believer
- दास्वान् (*dāsvān*)—let him be a generous giver

Gist

O Agni, the sacrificer who offers cooked food such as the purodāśa to you, who desire food in the form of oblation, who sets you up on the uttaravedi and offers the beneficial Soma, and who kindles you, divine in nature, in the sacrificial house: may the son of such a man be a firm believer and a generous giver.

English translation

May a son, firm in (devotion) and liberal (in offerings), be born to him who presents (srcrificial) food to you when needing food, who gives you constantly the exhilarating (Soma juice), who welcomes you as a guest, and devoutly kindles you in his mansion.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्त्वा॑ दो॒षा य उ॒षसि॑ प्र॒शंसा॑त्प्रि॒यं वा॑ त्वा कृ॒णव॑ते ह॒विष्मा॑न् ।
अश्वो॒ न स्वे दम॒ आ हे॒म्यावा॒न्तमंह॑सः पीपरो दा॒श्वांस॑म् ॥ ८ ॥

> *yastvā doṣā ya uṣasi praśaṃsātpriyaṃ vā tvā kṛṇavate haviṣmān |*
> *aśvo na sve dama ā hemyāvāntamaṃhasaḥ pīparo dāśvāṃsam ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । त्वा । दोषा । यः । उषसि । प्रशंसात् । प्रियं । वा । त्वा । कृणवते ।
> हविष्मान् ॥
> अश्वः । न । स्वे । दमे । आ । हेम्यावान् । तं । अंहसः । पीपरः । दाश्वांसं ॥ ८ ॥

> *yaḥ | tvā | doṣā | yaḥ | uṣasi | praśaṃsāt | priyaṃ | vā | tvā | kṛṇavate |*
> *haviṣmān ‖*
> *aśvaḥ | na | sve | dame | ā | hemyāvān | taṃ | aṃhasaḥ | pīparaḥ | dāśvāṃsaṃ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यः पुमान् दोषा दोषायां रात् त्वां प्रशंसात् संस्तुयात् ।
> यश्चोषसि प्रातःकाले त्वां प्रशंसेत् । हविष्मान् संभृतहविष्को यो वा यज–

> *he agne yaḥ pumān doṣā doṣāyāṃ rāt tvāṃ praśaṃsāt saṃstuyāt |*
> *yaścoṣasi prātaḥkāle tvāṃ praśaṃset | haviṣmān saṃbhṛtahaviṣko yo vā yaja-*

> मानस्त्वा त्वां प्रियं हविर्भिः प्रीतं कृणवते । कुर्यात् । आ अथ दाश्वांसं हविर्दत्तवंतं तं तादृशं यजमानं स्वे दमे स्वकीये गृहे हेम्यावान् सुवर्णनिर्मितकक्ष्यावानश्व न अश्व इव संचरंस्तमंहसः पापरूपाद्दारिद्रात्पीपरः ।
> पारं नय । तस्ये यजमानाय बहु धनं प्रयच्छेत्यर्थः ॥ दोषा । सप्तम्या
> आकारः । प्रशंसात् । शन्नु स्तुता । लेट्याडागमे रूपं । कृणवते । कृवि
> हिंसाकरणयोरित्यस्य लेटि धन्विकृण्वरच्चेत्युप्रत्ययः । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः ।
> यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । प्रत्ययस्वरः । हेम्यावान् । हेमार्हति । छंदसि चेति यः ।
> पीपरः । प्प पालनपूरणयोरित्यस्य ण्यंतस्य लुजु चजु रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *mānastvā tvāṃ priyaṃ havirbhiḥ prītaṃ kṛṇavate | kuryāt | ā atha dāśvāṃsaṃ havirdattavaṃtaṃ taṃ tādṛśaṃ yajamānaṃ sve dame svakīye gṛhe hemyāvān suvarṇanirmitakakṣyāvānaśca na aśva iva saṃcaraṃstamaṃhasaḥ pāparūpāddāridrātpīparaḥ |*
> *pāraṃ naya | tasyè yajamānāya bahu dhanaṃ prayacchetyarthaḥ ‖ doṣā | saptamyā*
> *ākāraḥ | praśaṃsāt | śannu stutā | leṭyāḍāgame rūpaṃ | kṛṇavate |*
> *kṛvi hiṃsākaraṇayorityasya leṭi dhanvikṛṇvaraccetyupratyayaḥ | leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ |*

> *hemyāvān | hemārhati | chaṃdasi ceti yaḥ |*
> *pīparaḥ | ppa pālanapūraṇayorityasya ṇyaṃtasya luju caju rūpaṃ |*
> *nighātaḥ* ‖

Summary

"O Agni, whatever man praises you by night (दोषा (*doṣā*), with the locative ending ā), and whoever praises you at dawn; or the sacrificer who, provided with oblations, having gathered his offering..." The sentence continues on the next page.

"...makes you dear, pleased with oblations. And then, that sacrificer who has given the oblation (दाश्वांसं (*dāśvāṃsaṃ*)), in his own house, like a horse wearing a girth made of gold moving about, carry him across (पीपरः (*pīparaḥ*) = take him to the far shore) from sin in the form of poverty; that is, give that sacrificer abundant wealth." Sāyaṇa adds that दोषा (*doṣā*) has the ending ā for the locative; प्रशंसात् (*praśaṃsāt*) is from the root for praise, a Leṭ form with the augment; कृणवते (*kṛṇavate*) is from the root kṛvi (harming, doing); हेम्यावान् (*hemyāvān*) means "deserving gold"; पीपरः (*pīparaḥ*) is an aorist-type form of the causative of pṝ ("protect, fill").

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Agni) यः (*yaḥ*)—which sacrificer
- दोषा (*doṣā*)—at night
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- प्रशंसात् (*praśaṃsāt*)—praises
- यः (*yaḥ*)—who
- उषसि (*uṣasi*)—praises also at dawn
- हविष्मान् वा (*haviṣmān vā*)—or which sacrificer, provided with oblation
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- प्रियं (*priyaṃ*)—as one pleased with oblations
- कृणवते (*kṛṇavate*)—makes
- दाश्वांसं (*dāśvāṃsaṃ*)—who offers the oblation
- तं (*taṃ*)—such a sacrificer
- स्वे दमे (*sve dame*)—in his house

- हेम्यावान् (*hemyāvān*)—adorned with golden ornaments
- अश्वो न (*aśvo na*)—moving about like a horse
- अंहसः (*aṃhasaḥ*)—from the poverty that is sin
- पीपरः (*pīparaḥ*)—bring to an end

Gist

O Agni, the sacrificer who praises you both at evening and at dawn and offers oblation: in the house of such a sacrificer, moving about like a horse adorned with gold, carry him across from poverty in the form of sin.

English translation

Preserve from sin the liberal sacrificer who glorifies you morning and evening, and, presenting oblations, does what is acceptable to you in his own abode, like a horse with golden caparisons

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्तुभ्य॑मग्ने अ॒मृता॑य॒ दाश॒द्दुव॒स्त्वे कृ॒णव॑ते य॒तस्रु॑क्
।
न स रा॒या श॑शमा॒नो वि यो॑ष॒न्नैन॒मंह॒ः परि॑ वर
दघा॒योः ॥ ९ ॥

> *yastubhyamagne amṛtāya dāśadduvastve kṛṇavate yatasruk |*
> *na sa rāyā śaśamāno vi yoṣannainamaṃhaḥ pari varadaghāyoḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । तुभ्यं । अग्ने । अमृताय । दाशत् । दुवः । त्वे इति । कृणमते । यतऽसुक् ।
> नः । सः । राया । शशमानः । वि । योषत् । न । एनं । अंहः । परि । वरत् । अघयोः ॥ ९
> ॥

> *yaḥ | tubhyaṃ | agne | amṛtāya | dāśat | duvaḥ | tve iti | kṛṇamate |*
> *yata 'suk |*
> *naḥ | saḥ | rāyā | śaśamānaḥ | vi | yoṣat | na | enaṃ | aṃhaḥ | pari |*
> *varat | aghayoḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यो यजमानोऽमृताय मरणधर्मरहिताय तुभ्यं दाशत्
> हवींषि प्रयच्छेत् । यतस्रुक् संयतस्रुक् यश्च यजमानस्त्वै त्वयि दुवः परिचर्यां कृणवते करोति
> शशमानः स्तोत्रं कुर्वाणः स यजमानो राया धनेन
> न वि योषत् । न पृथग्नवेत् । सदा धनयुक्तो भवेदित्यर्थः । अघायोः पापमिच्छतो हिंसकस्य
> संबंध्यंह आहननं पापमेनं यजमानं न परि वरत् । न
> परिवृणुयात् । न स्पृशेदित्यर्थः ॥ दाशत् । दाश्य दाने । लेट्यडागमे रूपं । त्वे ।
> सुपां सुलुगिति सप्तम्याः शे इत्यादेशः । कृणवते । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः ।
> योषत् । यु मिश्रणे । लेटि सिब्बहुलमिति सिप् । अडागमः । निघातः । वरत्,
> वृञ् वरणे । लेटि रूपं ॥

> *he agne yo yajamāno 'mṛtāya maraṇadharmarahitāya tubhyaṃ dāśat*
> *havīṃṣi prayacchet | yatasruk saṃyatasruk yaśca yajamānastvai tvayi*
> *duvaḥ paricaryāṃ kṛṇavate karoti śaśamānaḥ stotraṃ kurvāṇaḥ sa*
> *yajamāno rāyā dhanena*
> *na vi yoṣat | na pṛthagnavet | sadā dhanayukto bhavedityarthaḥ |*
> *aghāyoḥ pāpamicchato hiṃsakasya saṃbaṃdhyaṃha āhananaṃ*
> *pāpamenaṃ yajamānaṃ na pari varat | na*
> *parivṛṇuyāt | na spṛśedityarthaḥ ‖ dāśat | dāśya dāne | leṭyaḍāgame*
> *rūpaṃ | tve |*
> *supāṃ sulugiti saptamyāḥ śe ityādeśaḥ | kṛṇavate |*
> *yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ |*
> *yoṣat | yu miśraṇe | leṭi sibbahulamiti sip | aḍāgamaḥ | nighātaḥ |*
> *varat,*
> *vṛñ varaṇe | leṭi rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, the sacrificer who gives oblations to you, who are immortal, free from the nature of death; and the sacrificer who, holding up the ladle (यतस्रुक् (*yatasruk*)), performs service to you (त्वे (*tve*) = in you), reciting praise (शशमानः (*śaśamānaḥ*)): may that sacrificer not be separated from wealth (राया (*rāyā*)); that is, he should always be possessed of wealth. The अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*), the sin that strikes, belonging to the malevolent (अघायोः (*aghāyoḥ*)), the harmful one who wishes evil, should not encompass (परि वरत् (*pari varat*)) this sacrificer; that is, should not touch him." Sāyaṇa adds notes on forms: दाशत् (*dāśat*) (root dāś, giving), a Leṭ form with the augment; त्वे (*tve*) (locative replaced by śe); योषत् (*yoṣat*) (root yu, mixing); वरत् (*varat*) (root vṛñ, choosing or covering), a Leṭ form.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which sacrificer
- अमृताय (*amṛtāya*)—to the deathless
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—to you
- दाशत् (*dāśat*)—offers oblation
- यतस्रुक् (*yatasruk*)—holding up the oblation vessel
- त्वे (*tve*)—to you
- शशमानः (*śaśamānaḥ*)—reciting praise
- दुवः (*duvaḥ*)—service in the form of worship
- कृणवते (*kṛṇavate*)—does
- सः (*saḥ*)—such a sacrificer
- राया (*rāyā*)—by wealth
- न वि योषत् (*na vi yoṣat*)—let him not be separated
- अघायोः (*aghāyoḥ*)—of the sinful one
- अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*)—the sin in the form of harm
- एनं (*enaṃ*)—this sacrificer
- न परि वरत् (*na pari varat*)—let it not surround

Gist

O Agni, the sacrificer who offers oblation to you, who are deathless, and who, lifting the oblation vessel, renders you service in the form of praise: for such a sacrificer let there be no poverty of wealth. Let no kind of harm from an enemy surround him.

English translation

Let not him who makes offerings to you, Agni, who are immortal, who with uplifted ladle pours out oblations repeating your praise, ever want riches, and let not the wickedness of a malevolent (foe) circum- vent him

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्य॒ त्वम॑ग्ने अध्व॒रं जुजो॑षो दे॒वो मर्त॑स्य॒ सुधि॑तं॒ ररा॑णः ।
प्री॒तेद॑स॒द्धोत्रा॒ सा य॑वि॒ष्ठासा॑म॒ यस्य॑ विध॒तो वृ॒धास॑ः ॥ १० ॥

> *yasya tvamagne adhvaraṃ jujoṣo devo martasya sudhitaṃ rarāṇaḥ |*
> *prītedasaddhotrā sā yaviṣṭhāsāma yasya vidhato vṛdhāsaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यस्य । त्वं । अग्ने । आध्वरं । जुजोषः । देवः । मर्तस्य । सुधितं । रराणः ।
> प्रीता । इत् । आसत् । होत्रा । सा । यविष्ठ । असाम । यस्य । विधतः । वृधासः ॥१०॥

> *yasya | tvaṃ | agne | ādhvaraṃ | jujoṣaḥ | devaḥ | martasya |*
> *sudhitaṃ | rarāṇaḥ |*
> *prītā | it | āsat | hotrā | sā | yaviṣṭha | asāma | yasya | vidhataḥ |*
> *vṛdhāsaḥ ‖10‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने रराणो रममाणो देवो दीप्यमानस्त्वं यस्य मर्तस्य मनुष्यस्य संबंधि सुधितं त्वदर्थं सुष्टु निहितमध्वरमनुपहतं हनिर्लक्षणमन्नं
> जुजोषः सेवेथा हे यविष्ठ युवतम सा होत्रा स होता यजमानः प्रीतेदसत् । प्रीत एव भवेत् । असाम तस्य यजमानस्य संबंधिनो भवेम यस्य विधतोऽग्निपरिचर्यां कुर्वतो यजमानस्य होत्रादयो वृधासो यज्ञस्य वर्धयितारो भवंति ॥ जुजोषः । जुषी प्रीतिसेवनयोरित्यस्य बहुलं छंदसीति श्लुः ।
> अडागमः । अभ्यस्तस्वरः । सुधितं । दधातेर्निष्ठायां सुधितवसुधितेति निपातनात्

> ध्यादेशः । गतिरनंतर इति गतेः स्वरः । असाम ! आस्तेर्लोट्याडुत्तमस्य पिच्चेत्याडागमः । उत्तमस्य पिद्वद्भावादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । विधतः । विध विधाने । तुदादिः।
> शतुरनुम इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ॥

> *he agne rarāṇo ramamāṇo devo dīpyamānastvaṃ yasya martasya manuṣyasya saṃbaṃdhi sudhitaṃ tvadarthaṃ suṣṭu nihitamadhvaramanupahataṃ hanirlakṣaṇamannaṃ*
> *jujoṣaḥ sevethā he yaviṣṭha yuvatama sā hotrā sa hotā yajamānaḥ prītedasat | prīta eva bhavet | asāma tasya yajamānasya saṃbaṃdhino bhavema yasya vidhato 'gniparicaryāṃ kurvato yajamānasya hotrādayo vṛdhāso yajñasya vardhayitāro bhavaṃti ‖ jujoṣaḥ | juṣī prītisevanayorityasya bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śluḥ |*
> *aḍāgamaḥ | abhyastasvaraḥ | sudhitaṃ | dadhāterniṣṭhāyāṃ sudhitavasudhiteti nipātanāt*
> *dhyādeśaḥ | gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ svaraḥ | asāma ! āsterloṭyāḍuttamasya piccetyāḍāgamaḥ | uttamasya pidvadbhāvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | vidhataḥ | vidha vidhāne | tudādiḥ|*
> *śaturanuma iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, delighting (रराणः (*rarāṇaḥ*)), shining (देवः (*devaḥ*)), you who enjoy (जुजोषः (*jujoṣaḥ*)) the well-placed (सुधितं (*sudhitaṃ*)), unharmed (अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)) food in the form of oblation, properly set down for you, of the mortal, the man to whom it belongs: O youngest (यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)), that sacrificer (सा होत्रा (*sā hotrā*) = that hotṛ, the sacrificer) becomes pleased indeed. May we be (असाम (*asāma*)) connected with that sacrificer for whom, as he performs the service of Agni, the hotṛ and the others become promoters (वृधासः (*vṛdhāsaḥ*)) of the sacrifice." Sāyaṇa adds notes on forms: जुजोषः (*jujoṣaḥ*) (root juṣ, pleasure, service); सुधितं (*sudhitaṃ*) (root dhā, with the substitution dhi); असाम (*asāma*) (root as, Loṭ, with the augment); विधतः (*vidhataḥ*) (root vidh, of the tudādi class), with accent on the ending.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni

- रराणः (*rarāṇaḥ*)—delighting
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—shining
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- यस्य मर्तस्य (*yasya martasya*)—of which man
- सुधितं (*sudhitaṃ*)—offered according to rule
- अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)—the food in the form of oblation
- जुजोषः (*jujoṣaḥ*)—do you enjoy
- सा होत्रा (*sā hotrā*)—that sacrificer
- प्रीतेदसत् (*prītedasat*)—becomes pleased
- यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)—O Agni, the young
- यस्य विधतः (*yasya vidhataḥ*)—to the sacrifices and the like of which sacrificer
- वृधासः (*vṛdhāsaḥ*)—(the hotṛ and the others) are promoters of growth
- असाम (*asāma*)—may we increase the connection (with that sacrificer)

Gist

O Agni, you who shine, delighting: the man whose oblation-food, offered according to rule, you enjoy, that sacrificer becomes pleased. O youthful Agni, may we increase the connection with that sacrificer to whose sacrifices the hotṛ and the others are promoters of growth.

English translation

May that prayer be agreeable to you, Agni, who are a gracious deity, (which is uttered) by the man with whose well-conducted sacrifice you are well pleased, youngest (of the gods), of whose (rites) when worshipping you may we be the promoters.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

चित्ति॒मचि॑त्तिं चिनव॒द्वि वि॒द्वान्पृ॒ष्ठेव॑ वी॒ता वृ॑जि॒ना
च॒ मर्ता॑न् ।
रा॒ये च॑ नः स्वप॒त्याय॑ देव॒ दिति॑ं च॒ रास्वादि॑तिमु
रुष्य ॥ ११ ॥

> *cittimacittiṃ cinavadvi vidvānpṛṣṭheva vītā vṛjinā ca martān |*
> *rāye ca naḥ svapatyāya deva ditiṃ ca rāsvāditimuruṣya ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> चित्तिं । अचित्तिं । चिनवत् । वि । विद्वान् । पृष्ठा इव । वीता । वृजिना । च । मर्तान् ।
> राये । च । नः । सुअपत्याय । देव । दितिं । च । रास्व । अदितिं । उरुष्य ॥ ११ ॥

> *cittiṃ | acittiṃ | cinavat | vi | vidvān | pṛṣṭhā iva | vītā | vṛjinā | ca |*
> *martān |*
> *rāye | ca | naḥ | suapatyāya | deva | ditiṃ | ca | rāsva | aditiṃ |*
> *uruṣya ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विद्वान् प्राणिन ० पुण्यपापरूपाणि कर्माणि जानानः सोऽग्निश्चित्तिं ज्ञातव्यं
> पुण्यमचित्तिमनुपादेयत्वेनाचेतनीयं पापं । यद्वा । चित्तिं ज्ञानमचित्तिमज्ञानं वि चिनवत् ।
> विचिनोतु । पृथक्करोतु । तत्र दृष्टांतः । पृष्ठेव । यथाश्वपालोऽश्वानां वीता कांतानि वृजिना
> दुर्वहाणि च पृष्ठा पृष्ठानि ज्ञेयोपादेयत्वेन पृथक्करोति तद्वत् । किंच मर्तान्पुण्य कृतोऽपुण्यकृतश्च
> मनुष्यान् पृथक्करोतु । हे देवाग्ने स्वपत्याय शोभनपुत्रोपेताय राये धनाय नोऽस्मान्
> कुरु । दितिं दातारं च रास्व । देहि । अदितिं । पंचम्यर्थे द्वितीया । अदातुः
> सकाशादुरुष्य । रक्ष ॥ चित्तिं । चिती संज्ञाने । स्त्रियां क्तिन् । नित्याद्युदात्तः ।
> चिनवत् । चिनोतेर्लेट्यडागमः । दितिं । दाण् दाने । कर्तरि क्तिन् । रास्व । रा
> दाने । लोटि व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । चवायोगे प्रथमेति न निघातः ॥

> *vidvān prāṇina o puṇyapāparūpāṇi karmāṇi jānānaḥ so 'gniścittiṃ*
> *jñātavyaṃ*
> *puṇyamacittimanupādeyatvenācetanīyaṃ pāpaṃ | yadvā | cittiṃ*

> *jñānamacittimajñānaṃ vi cinavat | vicinotu | pṛthakkarotu | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | pṛṣṭeva | yathāśvapālo 'śvānāṃ vītā kāṃtāni vṛjinā durvahāṇi ca pṛṣṭhā pṛṣṭhāni jñeyopādeyatvena pṛthakkaroti tadvat | kiṃca martānpuṇya kṛto 'puṇyakṛtaśca manuṣyān pṛthakkarotu | he devāgne svapatyāya śobhanaputropetāya rāye dhanāya no 'smān kuru | ditiṃ dātāraṃ ca rāsva | dehi | aditiṃ | paṃcamyarthe dvitīyā | adātuḥ*
> *sakāśāduruṣya | rakṣa || cittiṃ | citī saṃjñāne | striyāṃ ktin | nityādyudāttaḥ |*
> *cinavat | cinoterlèṭyaḍāgamaḥ | ditiṃ | dāṇ dāne | kartari ktin | rāsva | rā*
> *dāne | loṭi vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | cavāyoge prathameti na nighātaḥ ||*

Summary

"The knowing (विद्वान् (*vidvān*)) Agni, who knows the deeds of beings, in the form of merit and sin, should discern (चित्तिं (*cittiṃ*)) the merit that is to be known, and (अचित्तिं (*acittiṃ*)) the sin that is not to be thought of, being unfit to be taken up. Or else: चित्तिं (*cittiṃ*) is knowledge and अचित्तिं (*acittiṃ*) ignorance; let him separate them (वि चिनवत् (*vi cinavat*)). The example: पृष्ठेव (*pṛṣṭheva*); as a groom of horses separates the backs (पृष्ठा (*pṛṣṭhā*)) of horses into the lovely (वीता (*vītā*)) and the hard to bear (वृजिना (*vṛjinā*)), as to what is to be known and taken up, so he. Moreover, let him separate mortals, those who do merit and those who do not. O divine Agni, make us (नः (*naḥ*)) possessed of wealth (राये (*rāye*)) with good offspring (स्वपत्याय (*svapatyāya*)). Give (रास्व (*rāsva*)) the giver (दितिं (*ditiṃ*)). अदितिं (*aditiṃ*) has the accusative in the sense of the ablative: protect (उरुष्य (*uruṣya*)) us from the one who does not give." Sāyaṇa adds notes on forms: चित्तिं (*cittiṃ*) (root cit, to perceive; suffix ktin); चिनवत् (*cinavat*) (root ci, Leṭ with the augment); दितिं (*ditiṃ*) (root dā, giving; ktin in the agent sense); रास्व (*rāsva*) (root rā, giving; ātmanepada by vyatyaya).

Word-to-word meaning

- वीता (*vītā*)—the lovely parts (of the horse's back)
- वृजिना (*vṛjinā*)—and the unbearable parts
- पृषेव (*pṛṣeva*)—as a groom separates them

- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—Agni, the all-knowing
- चित्तिं (*cittiṃ*)—merit
- अचित्तिं (*acittiṃ*)—and sin
- वि चिनवत् (*vi cinavat*)—let him separate
- मर्तान् (*martān*)—among men too, let him separate those who do merit from the sinful
- देव (*deva*)—O Agni
- स्वपत्याय (*svapatyāya*)—with excellent sons
- राये (*rāye*)—grant us to become sharers in wealth
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- दितिं (*ditiṃ*)—the giver
- रास्व (*rāsva*)—give
- अदितिं (*aditiṃ*)—from the non-giver
- उरुष्य (*uruṣya*)—protect

Gist

As a groom of horses separates the lovely and the unbearable parts on a horse's back, so may Agni, the all-knowing, separate merit and sin. Among men too, may he separate those who do merit from the sinful. O Agni, make us sharers in wealth along with excellent sons. Give us an excellent giver, and protect us from the non-giver.

English translation

May the wise Agni, discriminate between virtue and vice, between (virtuous and wicked) men, as a (groom distinguishes between (the strong ard weak backs (of horses) : enrich us with wealth accompanied by virtuous offspring : be bountiful to the liberal giver : shun him who gives not.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒विं शं॑शासुः क॒वयोऽदं॑ब्धा निधा॒रयं॑न्तो॒ दुर्यां॑स्वा॒
योः ।
अत॒स्त्वं दृश्याँ अग्न ए॒तान्प॒ड्भिः पं॑श्ये॒रद्भुं॑ताँ अ॒र्य ए
वैं॑◌ः ॥ १२ ॥

> *kaviṃ śaśāsuḥ kavayo 'dabdhā nidhārayanto duryāsvāyoḥ |*
> *atastvaṃ dṛśyā~ agna etānpaḍbhiḥ paśyeradbhutā~ arya evaiḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कविं । शशासुः । कवयः । अदब्धा । निर्धारयंतः । दुर्यासु । आयोः ।
> अतः । त्वं । दृश्यान् । अग्ने । एतान् । पट्भिः । पश्येः । अद्भुतान् । आर्यः ।
> एवैः ॥ १२ ॥

> *kaviṃ | śaśāsuḥ | kavayaḥ | adabdhā | nirdhārayaṃtaḥ | duryāsu |*
> *āyoḥ |*
> *ataḥ | tvaṃ | dṛśyān | agne | etān | paṭbhiḥ | paśyeḥ | adbhutān |*
> *āryaḥ |*
> *evaiḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने आयोर्मनुष्यस्य दुर्यासु गृहेष्टदब्धाः केनाप्यतिरस्कृता निधारयंतो निवसंतः कवयः क्रांतदृशो देवाः कविं मेधाविनं त्वां शशासुः ;
> होता भवेति शशंसुः । अतः कारणादर्यो यज्ञस्य स्वामी त्वं
> दृश्यान्दर्शनीयानद्भुतानाश्चर्यरूपोपेतानिंद्रादीनेतान्नेवानेवैर्गमनशीलैः पद्भिः पादैः स्वतेजोभिः पश्येः । जानीयाः ॥ दृश्यान् । दृशिर् प्रेक्षणे । ऋदुपधाच्चाकृपिचृतेः ।
> पा. ३–१–११० । इति कर्मणि क्यप् । कित्वादगुणः । पित्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः ॥

> *he agne āyormanuṣyasya duryāsu gṛheṣṭadabdhāḥ kenāpyatiraskṛtā nidhārayaṃto nivasaṃtaḥ kavayaḥ krāṃtadṛśo devāḥ kaviṃ medhāvinaṃ tvāṃ śaśāsuḥ ;*
> *hotā bhaveti śaśaṃsuḥ | ataḥ kāraṇādaryo yajñasya svāmī tvaṃ*

> *dṛśyāndarśanīyānadbhutānāścaryarūpopetānimṃdrādīnetānnevānevairga manaśīlaiḥ padbhiḥ pādaiḥ svatejobhiḥ paśyeḥ | jānīyāḥ ‖ dṛśyān | dṛśir prekṣaṇe | ṛdupadhāccākṛpicṛteḥ |*
> *pā. 3-1-110 | iti karmaṇi kyap | kitvādaguṇaḥ | pitvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni! The sages (कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)), the gods of far-reaching vision, who dwell undespised, unslighted by anyone, in the houses of Āyu, that is, of man, have urged you, the wise one (कविं (*kaviṃ*)), to be the Hotṛ." For this reason you, the lord of the sacrifice (आर्यः (*āryaḥ*)), with your swift-moving feet, that is, with your own splendours, behold and know these visible, wondrous gods, Indra and the others, who are endowed with marvellous forms. (The rest is grammar: दृश्यान् (*dṛśyān*) is formed from the root दृशिर् (*dṛśir*) in the sense of seeing.)

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- आयोः (*āyoḥ*)—of man
- दुरासु (*durāsu*)—in the houses
- अदब्धाः (*adabdhāḥ*)—free from contempt
- निधारयंत (*nidhārayaṃta*)—dwelling
- कवयः (*kavayaḥ*)—the sages, of far-reaching vision
- कविं (*kaviṃ*)—you, the wise one
- शशासुः (*śaśāsuḥ*)—praised (saying "you must be the Hotṛ")
- अतः (*ataḥ*)—therefore
- आर्यः (*āryaḥ*)—the lord
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- दृश्यान् (*dṛśyān*)—those of attractive form
- अद्भुतान् (*adbhutān*)—those of marvellous form
- एतान् (*etān*)—these gods, Indra and the others
- एवैः (*evaiḥ*)—moving
- पद्भिः (*padbhiḥ*)—with your splendours
- पश्येः (*paśyeḥ*)—you behold and know

Gist

O Agni, the sages of far-reaching vision, who dwell undespised in the house of the sacrificer, have praised you, the wise one, saying "you must be the Hotṛ." Therefore you, the lord, behold and know, with your moving splendours, these gods, Indra and the others, who have attractive and marvellous forms.

English translation

The unreviled sages abiding in the dwellings of man have glorified the sage (Agni); therefore, lord of sacrifice, you may proceed with swift- moving feet to behold the admirable and marvellous deities.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वम॑ग्ने वा॒घते॑ सु॒प्रणी॑तिः सु॒तसो॑माय विध॒ते य॑विष्ठ ।
रत्नं॑ भर शशमा॒नायं॑ घृष्वे पृ॒थु श्च॒न्द्रमवं॑से चर्षणि॒प्राः ॥ १३ ॥

> *tvamagne vāghate supraṇītiḥ sutasomāya vidhate yaviṣṭha |*
> *ratnaṃ bhara śaśamānāya ghṛṣve pṛthu ścandramavase carṣaṇiprāḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । अग्ने । वाघते । सुप्रनीतिः । सुतसोमाय । विधते । यविष्ठ ।
> रत्नं । भर । शशमानाय । फृष्टे । पृथु । चंद्रं । अवसे । चर्षणिप्राः ॥ १३ ॥

> *tvaṃ | agne | vāghate | supranītiḥ | sutasomāya | vidhate | yaviṣṭha |*
> *ratnaṃ | bhara | śaśamānāya | phṛṣṭe | pṛthu | caṃdraṃ | avase |*
> *carṣaṇiprāḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे यविष्ठ युवतम फृष्टे दीप्तियुक्त । यद्वा । परेषां घर्षणशील हे
> अग्ने चर्षणिप्रा अपेक्षितप्रदानेन मनुष्याणां कामपूरकः सुप्रणीति: सुसूत्तरवेद्यां प्रणयनीयस्त्वं
> सुतसोमाय विधते तव परिचरणं कुर्वते शशमानाय
> त्वां स्तुवते वाघते यज्ञनिर्वाहकाय यजमानाय पृथु प्रभूतं चंद्रमाह्लादकारि रत्नमुत्तमं धनमवसे
> रक्षणाय भर । आहर । प्रयच्छेत्यर्थः ॥ सुप्रणीति: ।
> णीञ् प्रापणे । कर्मणि क्तिन् । तादौ च निति कृतीत्यनंतरप्रशब्दस्योदात्तत्वं ।
> पृथु श्चंद्रमित्यत्र संहितायां ह्रस्वाच्चंद्रोत्तरपदे मंत्र इति सुडागमः ।
> श्चुत्वेन शकारः ॥

> *he yaviṣṭha yuvatama phṛṣṭe dīptiyukta | yadvā | pareṣāṃ gharṣaṇaśīla he*
> *agne carṣaṇiprā apekṣitapradānena manuṣyāṇāṃ kāmapūrakaḥ supraṇīti: susūttaravedyāṃ praṇayanīyastvaṃ sutasomāya vidhate tava paricaraṇaṃ kurvate śaśamānāya*
> *tvāṃ stuvate vāghate yajñanirvāhakāya yajamānāya pṛthu prabhūtaṃ caṃdramāhlādakāri ratnamuttamaṃ dhanamavase rakṣaṇāya bhara | āhara | prayacchetyarthaḥ ‖ supraṇīti: |*
> *ṇīñ prāpaṇe | karmaṇi ktin | tādau ca niti kṛtītyanaṃtarapraśabdasyodāttatvaṃ |*
> *pṛthu ścaṃdramityatra saṃhitāyāṃ hrasvāccaṃdrottarapade maṃtra iti suḍāgamaḥ |*
> *ścutvena śakāraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Yaviṣṭha, youngest, O फृष्टे (*phṛṣṭe*), endowed with radiance; or else, O one who crushes others; O Agni, you who fulfil men's wishes by granting what they desire (चर्षणिप्राः (*carṣaṇiprāḥ*)), and who are to be well led forward (सुप्रणीतिः (*supraṇītiḥ*)) on the northern altar: bring (भर (*bhara*), that is, give) excellent, abundant, delight-giving wealth, for his protection, to the sacrificer who accomplishes the sacrifice, who has pressed Soma for you, who attends upon you, who praises you. (The rest is grammar: सुप्रणीति: (*supraṇīti:*) from the root णीञ् (*ṇīñ*) in the sense of leading; the accent; the augment *suṭ* in पृथु । चंद्रं (*pṛthu | caṃdraṃ*) in the Saṃhitā; the श्चुत्व (*ścutva*) change to the sibilant.)

Word-to-word meaning

- यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)—O extremely young one
- फृष्टे (*phṛṣṭe*)—O destroyer of enemies
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- चर्षणिप्राः (*carṣaṇiprāḥ*)—you who grant what is desired
- सुप्रणीतिः (*supraṇītiḥ*)—who are established on the northern altar by the excellent rite
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- सुतसोमाय (*sutasomāya*)—to him who has pressed Soma for you
- विधते (*vidhate*)—to him who serves you
- शशमानाय (*śaśamānāya*)—to him who praises you
- वाघते (*vāghate*)—to the sacrificer, who accomplishes the sacrifice
- पृथु (*pṛthu*)—abundant
- चंद्रं (*caṃdraṃ*)—delight-giving
- रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)—excellent wealth
- अवसे (*avase*)—for his protection
- भर (*bhara*)—provide

Gist

O Agni, extremely young and destroyer of enemies, you who grant what is desired and are established on the northern altar by the excellent rite: provide, for the protection of the sacrificer, who presses Soma and offers it to you, who praises and serves you and accomplishes the sacrifice, abundant, delight-giving and excellent wealth.

English translation

Resplendent Agni, youngest of the gods, the satisfier of (the desires of) men, who are easily to be conducted (to the altar), bestow joy-yielding and abundant wealth for his preservation upon the worshipper who praises and worships you and offers you libations.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अधा॑ ह॒ यद्व॒यम॑ग्ने त्वा॒या प॒ड्भिर्हस्ते॑भिश्चकृ॒मा त॒नूभि॑ः ।
रथं॒ न क्रन्तो॒ अप॑सा भु॒रिजो॑र्ऋ॒तं ये॑मुः सु॒ध्य॑ आशु॒षाणाः ॥ १४ ॥

> *adhā ha yadvayamagne tvāyā paḍbhirhastebhiścakṛmā tanūbhiḥ |*
> *rathaṃ na kranto apasā bhurijorṛtaṃ yemuḥ sudhya āśuṣāṇāḥ ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अध । ह । यत् । वयं । अग्ने । त्वाया । पट्भिः । हस्तेभिः । चक्रम । तनूभिः ।
> रथं । न । क्रंतः । अपसा । भुरिजोः । ऋतं । येमुः । सुध्यः । आशुषाणाः ॥१४॥

> *adha | ha | yat | vayaṃ | agne | tvāyā | paṭbhiḥ | hastebhiḥ | cakrama | tanūbhiḥ |*
> *rathaṃ | na | kraṃtaḥ | apasā | bhurijoḥ | ṛtaṃ | yemuḥ | sudhyaḥ | āśuṣāṇāḥ ‖14‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने अध ह अथ खलु वयं त्वाया त्वत्कामनया पद्भिः पादैर्हस्तेभिर्हस्तेस्तनूभिरन्यैश्चावयवैश्चक्रम यत् यस्मात्कारणात्कर्मसिद्ध्यर्थं त्वामुपपादयामस्तस्मात्तुध्यः सुकर्माण आशुषाणाः कर्माणि व्याप्प्नुवंतस्तेंगिरस ऋतं

> *he agne adha ha atha khalu vayaṃ tvāyā tvatkāmanayā padbhiḥ pādairhastebhirhastestanūbhiranyaiścāvayavaiścakrama yat yasmātkāraṇātkarmasiddhyarthaṃ tvāmupapādayāmastasmāttudhyaḥ sukarmāṇa āśuṣāṇāḥ karmāṇi vyāppnuvaṃtastemgirasa ṛtaṃ*

> सत्यभूतं त्वां भुरिजोः । बिभृतः कर्मकरणसामर्थ्यं पदार्थान्वेति भुरिजौ बाहू । तयोरपसा मंथनाख्येन कर्मणा येमुः । उद्यच्छंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । रथं न । यथा क्रंतः कारवः शिल्पिनः क्रामंतोऽध्वगा वा हस्तयोर्यथा रथमुद्यच्छंति तद्वत् । यद्वा । भुरिजोः । देवान्मनुष्यांश्च बिभृत इति भुरिजौ द्यावापृथिव्यौ । तयोर्मध्येऽपसा परिचरणकर्मणा सत्यभूतं तमग्निं येमुः । उद्यच्छंति ॥ अध । संहितायां निपातस्य चेति

> दीर्घः ! क्रंतः । करोतेः शतरि बहुलं
> छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । प्रत्ययस्वरः । भुरिजोः । डुभृञ् धारणपोषणयोः ।
> भृञ उच्च । उ. २–७१ । इतीजिप्रत्ययः । धातोरुकारो रपरः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥

> *satyabhūtaṃ tvāṃ bhurijoḥ | bibhṛtaḥ karmakaraṇasāmarthyaṃ padārthānveti bhurijau*
> *bāhū | tayorapasā maṃthanākhyena karmaṇā yemuḥ | udyacchaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *rathaṃ na | yathā kraṃtaḥ kāravaḥ śilpinaḥ krāmaṃto 'dhvagā vā hastayoryathā rathamudyacchaṃti tadvat | yadvā | bhurijoḥ | devānmanuṣyāṃśca bibhṛta iti bhurijau dyāvāpṛthivyau | tayormadhye 'pasā paricaraṇakarmaṇā satyabhūtaṃ tamagniṃ yemuḥ | udyacchaṃti ‖ adha | saṃhitāyāṃ nipātasya ceti dīrghaḥ ! kraṃtaḥ | karoteḥ śatari bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk | pratyayasvaraḥ | bhurijoḥ | ḍubhṛñ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayoḥ |*
> *bhṛña ucca | u. 2-71 | itījipratyayaḥ | dhātorukāro raparaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, अध ह (*adha ha*) means "now indeed": we have laboured with desire for you (त्वाया (*tvāyā*)), with feet, hands, bodies and other limbs. Because for the success of the rite we thus prepare you, therefore the good workers (सुध्यः (*sudhyaḥ*)), the Aṅgirases, who pervade the rites (आशुषाणाः (*āśuṣāṇāḥ*)), ...the true one (ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)) (the sentence continues on the next page).

(Continuing:) ...you who are true (सत्यभूतं (*satyabhūtaṃ*)). भुरिजोः (*bhurijoḥ*): the two arms, which bear the capacity to perform work; with the work called churning performed by these two, they lift up (येमुः (*yemuḥ*), "raise") Agni. The example: रथं न (*rathaṃ na*), as craftsmen (क्रंतः (*kraṃtaḥ*)) or travellers lift a chariot with their hands. Or else: भुरिजोः (*bhurijoḥ*) are heaven and earth, which bear gods and men; between these two, by the work of service, they raise Agni, who is true. (The rest is grammar: the lengthening in अध (*adha*) in the Saṃhitā; क्रंतः (*kraṃtaḥ*) from the root करोतेः (*karoteḥ*) with the participial affix; भुरिजोः (*bhurijoḥ*) from डुभृञ् (*ḍubhṛñ*) with the affix *iji*, Uṇ. Sū. 2-71.)[?364]

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अध ह (*adha ha*)—afterwards
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- त्वाया (*tvāyā*)—desiring your favour
- पद्भिः (*padbhiḥ*)—with feet
- हस्तेभिः (*hastebhiḥ*)—with hands
- तनूभिः (*tanūbhiḥ*)—with other excellent limbs
- यत् (*yat*)—for which favour
- चक्रम (*cakrama*)—we prepare ourselves for your service (then)
- क्रंतः (*kraṃtaḥ*)—craftsmen
- रथं न (*rathaṃ na*)—as they refine and build a chariot
- सुध्यः (*sudhyaḥ*)—good performers of rites
- आशुषाणाः (*āśuṣāṇāḥ*)—the Aṅgirases, intent on the rites
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—you, who are of the nature of truth
- भुरिजोः (*bhurijoḥ*)—of their arms
- अपसा (*apasā*)—by laborious work
- येमुः (*yemuḥ*)—they make ready

Gist

O Agni, when we, desiring your favour, prepare ourselves for your service with our hands, our feet and our other excellent limbs, the Aṅgirases, good performers of rites and intent on the rites, perfect your worship by the labour of their arms, as craftsmen refine and build a chariot.

English translation

Therefore, Agni, when we labour for you with hands and feet, and all our members, the pious performers of rites, (the Angirasas), exercise their arms in the work (of attrition), as wheelwrights fabricate a car.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अधा॑ मा॒तुरु॒षसः॑ स॒प्त विप्रा॒ जाये॑महि प्रथ॒मा वे॒धसो॒ नॄन् ।
दि॒वस्पु॒त्रा अङ्गि॑रसो भवे॒माद्रिं॑ रुजेम ध॒निनं॑ शु॒चन्तः॑ ॥ १५ ॥

> *adhā māturuṣasaḥ sapta viprā jāyemahi prathamā vedhaso nṝn |*
> *divasputrā aṅgiraso bhavemādriṃ rujema dhaninaṃ śucantaḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अध । मातुः । उषसः । सप्त । विप्राः । जायेमहि । प्रथमाः । वेधसः । नृन् ।
> दिवः । पुत्राः । अंगिरसः । भवेम । अद्रिं । रुजेम । धनिनं । शुचंतः ॥ १५ ॥

> *adha | mātuḥ | uṣasaḥ | sapta | viprāḥ | jāyemahi | prathamāḥ | vedhasaḥ | nṛn |*
> *divaḥ | putrāḥ | aṃgirasaḥ | bhavema | adriṃ | rujema | dhaninaṃ | śucaṃtaḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वामदेवोऽनैः षड्भिरंगिरोभिः सह ब्रूते । अधापि च मातुरुषसः सकाशात्सप्त सप्तसंख्याका
> विप्राः प्राज्ञा वयं स्मः । प्रथमाः श्रेष्ठा वयं वेधसोऽग्नेः परिचारकान्नान् वेधसो विधातन् रश्मिन्
> ना जायेमहि। वयं जनयामः।
> दिवो द्योतमानस्यादित्यस्य पुत्रा वयमंगिरसो भवेम । भूतिमंतः स्याम ।
> शुचंतो दीप्यमाना वयं धनिनमुदकवंतमद्रिं मेघं रुजेम । वर्षार्थं
> भिंद्याम । यद्वा । धनिनं पणिनामकासुरापहृतगोधनयुक्तमद्रिं पर्वतं
> रुजेम । अंगिरसामादित्यपुत्रत्वमेवमाम्नायते । तस्य यद्रेतसः प्रथममुददीप्यत
> तदसावादित्योऽभवदित्युपक्रम्य येऽंगारा आसंस्थेऽंगिरसोऽभवन् । ऐ.
> ब्रा– ३–३४ । इति ॥ जायेमहि । जनी प्रादुर्भावे । लिङु ज्ञाजनोर्जेति जादेशः ।
> वेधसः । डुधाण् धारणपोषणयोरित्यस्माद्विधाइतो वेध च । उ– ४–२२४ । इत्यसिप्रत्ययः
> । धातोर्वेध इत्यादेशः । दिवस्सुत्रा इत्यत्र संहितायां षष्याः पतिपुत्रेति
> विसर्जनीयस्य सत्वं । रुजेम । रुजो भंगे । अदादिः । लिङु रूपं ॥

> *vāmadevo 'naiḥ ṣaḍbhiraṃgirobhiḥ saha brūte | adhāpi ca māturuṣasaḥ sakāśātsapta saptasaṃkhyākā viprāḥ prājñā vayaṃ smaḥ | prathamāḥ śreṣṭhā vayaṃ vedhaso 'gneḥ paricārakānnān vedhaso vidhātan raśmin nā jāyemahi| vayaṃ janayāmaḥ|*
> *divo dyotamānasyādityasya putrā vayamaṃgiraso bhavema |*
> *bhūtimaṃtaḥ syāma |*
> *śucaṃto dīpyamānā vayaṃ dhaninamudakavaṃtamadriṃ meghaṃ rujema | varṣārthaṃ*
> *bhiṃdyāma | yadvā | dhaninaṃ paṇināmakāsurāpahṛtagodhanayuktamadriṃ parvataṃ rujema | aṃgirasāmādityaputratvamevamāmnāyate | tasya yadretasaḥ prathamamudadīpyata tadasāvādityo 'bhavadityupakramya ye 'ṃgārā āsaṃsthe 'ṃgiraso 'bhavan | ai.*
> *brā- 3-34 | iti ‖ jāyemahi | janī prādurbhāve | liju jñājanorjèti jādeśaḥ | vedhasaḥ | ḍudhāṇ dhāraṇapoṣaṇayorityasmādvidhāito vedha ca | u-4-224 | ityasipratyayaḥ | dhātorvèdha ityādeśaḥ | divassutrā ityatra saṃhitāyāṃ ṣaṣyāḥ patiputreti*
> *visarjanīyasya satvaṃ | rujema | rujo bhaṃge | adādiḥ | liju rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

Vāmadeva speaks together with six other Aṅgirases. "And now, from the mother Uṣas we are seven wise ones (विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)); we are the first, the best. We generate the ..., the attendants of Agni, the rays."[?365]. "May we, sons of the shining Āditya (heaven), be Aṅgirases, that is, prosperous. Shining, may we split the watery (धनिनं (*dhaninaṃ*)) mountain (अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)), the cloud, for the sake of rain." Or else: may we split the mountain that holds the cattle-wealth carried off by the asura named Paṇi. The sonship of the Aṅgirases to Āditya is thus handed down: beginning "that which first blazed up of his seed became that Āditya," it says that the embers became the Aṅgirases: तस्य यद्रेतसः प्रथममुददीप्यत तदसावादित्योऽभवदित्युपक्रम्य येऽंगारा आसंस्थेऽंगिरसोऽभवन् । ऐ. (*tasya yadretasaḥ prathamamudadīpyata tadasāvādityo 'bhavadityupakramya ye 'ṃgārā āsaṃsthe 'ṃgiraso 'bhavan | ai.*) (Ai. Brā. 3-34). (The rest is grammar: जायेमहि (*jāyemahi*) from जनी (*janī*) with *liṅ* and the substitute जा (*jā*); वेधसः (*vedhasaḥ*) with the affix *asi*, Uṇ. Sū. 4-224; the visarga becoming स (*sa*) in दिवस्पुत्रा (*divasputrā*); रुजेम (*rujema*) from रुजो (*rujo*) in the sense of breaking.)

Word-to-word meaning

- प्रथमाः (*prathamāḥ*)—the best
- सप्त (*sapta*)—seven in number (seven persons)
- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—the wise ones; we
- मातुः (*mātuḥ*)—of the mother of the world
- उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*)—from Uṣas
- वेधसः (*vedhasaḥ*)—of Agni
- नृन् (*nṛn*)—the rays
- जायेमहि (*jāyemahi*)—we bring forth
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the shining Āditya
- पुत्राः (*putrāḥ*)—sons
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we, who are famed as Aṅgirases
- भवेम (*bhavema*)—may we become possessed of prosperity
- शुचंतः (*śucaṃtaḥ*)—we, shining
- धनिनं (*dhaninaṃ*)—watery
- अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)—the cloud
- रुजेम (*rujema*)—let us split (or let us release the mountain that holds cattle-wealth)

Gist

We, the best, seven in number and wise, bring forth the rays of Agni from Uṣas, the mother of the world. May we, who are sons of the shining Āditya and famed as Aṅgirases, be possessed of prosperity. Shining, may we split the mountain that holds cattle-wealth and obtain the cattle.

English translation

May we seven priests first in order engender from the maternal dawn the worshippers of the creator (Agni); may we Angirasas be the sons of heaven, and, radiant, divide the wealth-containing mauntain.

Special Topics

अंगिरसः (*aṃgirasaḥ*)—आदित्यस्य पुत्राः अंगिरसः (*ādityasya putrāḥ aṃgirasaḥ*). On the origin of the Aṅgirases see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 3, p. 520, and Part 10, p. 269; and see also the special topics of the 15th ṛk of the third sūkta.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अधा॒ यथा॑ नः पि॒तरः॒ परा॑सः प्र॒त्नासो॑ अग्न ऋ॒तमा॑शुषा॒णाः ।
शुचीद॑य॒न्दीधि॑तिमुक्थ॒शासः॒ क्षामा॑ भि॒न्दन्तो॑ अरु॒णीरप॑ व्रन् ॥ १६ ॥

> *adhā yathā naḥ pitaraḥ parāsaḥ pratnāso agna ṛtamāśuṣāṇāḥ |*
> *śucīdayandīdhitimukthaśāsaḥ kṣāmā bhindanto aruṇīrapa vran ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अध । यथा । नः । पितरः । परासः । प्रत्नासः । अग्ने । ऋतं । आशुषाणाः ।
> शुचि । इत् । अयन् । दीधितिं । उक्तशसः । क्षाम । भिंदंतः । अरुणीः । अप ।
> व्रन् ॥ १६ ॥

> *adha | yathā | naḥ | pitaraḥ | parāsaḥ | pratnāsaḥ | agne | ṛtaṃ | āśuṣāṇāḥ |*
> *śuci | it | ayan | dīdhitiṃ | uktaśasaḥ | kṣāma | bhiṃdaṃtaḥ | aruṇīḥ | apa |*
> *vran ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने अधापि च परासः श्रेष्ठाः प्रत्नासः पुराणा ऋतं सत्यभूतं यज्ञं
> यथा यथावदाशुषाणा अश्नुवाना नोऽस्माकं पितरोंगिरसः शुचि दीप्तं स्थानमयन । अगच्छन् ।
> तथा दीधितिं तेजश्चागच्छन् । किंच उक्तशास उक्तानां शस्त्राणां शंसितारः क्षाम क्षयकारणं
> तमः पापं ना भिंदंतो विनाशयंतोऽगिरसोरुणीररुणवर्णाः पणिभिरपहृता गा उषसो ना अप
> व्रन् । अपावृण्वन् ।

> प्रकाशितवंत इत्यर्थः ॥ अयन् । इण् गत् । लजूणो यण्णिति यण् । व्यत्ययेनाडागमः । दीधितिं । दीधिज् दीप्ति देवनयोरित्यस्मात् क्तिनि ह्रस्वश्कांदसः । नित्तादाद्युदात्तः । उक्तशासः । उक्तशब्द उपपदे शन्नु स्तुतावित्यस्मान्मंत्रे श्वेतवहोक्षशस्सुरोडाशो ण्णिन्निति ण्णिन् नकारलोपश्च निपातनादेव । पदकाले ह्रस्वश्कांदसः ।
>
> अरुणीः । गौरादिजीषंतः । एकादेशस्वरः । व्रन् । वृणोतेर्लुङ् मंत्रे घसेत्यादिना चेर्लुक् । निघातः ॥

> *he agne adhāpi ca parāsaḥ śreṣṭhāḥ pratnāsaḥ purāṇā ṛtaṃ satyabhūtaṃ yajñaṃ*
>
> *yathā yathāvadāśuṣāṇā aśnuvānā no 'smākaṃ pitaroṃgirasaḥ śuci dīptaṃ sthānamayana | agacchan | tathā dīdhitiṃ tejaścāgacchan | kiṃca uktaśāsa uktānāṃ śastrāṇāṃ śaṃsitāraḥ kṣāma kṣayakāraṇaṃ tamaḥ pāpaṃ nā bhiṃdaṃto vināśayaṃto 'ṃgirasoruṇīraruṇavarṇāḥ paṇibhirapahṛtā gā uṣaso nā apa vran | apāvṛṇvan |*
>
> *prakāśitavaṃta ityarthaḥ ‖ ayan | iṇ gat | lajūṇo yaṇṇiti yaṇ | vyatyayenāḍāgamaḥ | dīdhitiṃ | dīdhij dīpti devanayorityasmāt ktini hrasvaśkāṃdasaḥ | nittādādyudāttaḥ | uktaśāsaḥ | uktaśabda upapade śannu stutāvityasmānmaṃtre śvetavahokṣaśassuroḍāśo ṇṇinniti ṇṇin nakāralopaśca nipātanādeva | padakāle hrasvaśkāṃdasaḥ |*
>
> *aruṇīḥ | gaurādijīṣaṃtaḥ | ekādeśasvaraḥ | vran | vṛṇoterluṅ maṃtre ghasetyādinā cerluk | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa construes the verse as follows. "O Agni, and further, our fathers the Aṅgirases, who are excellent (परासः (*parāsaḥ*)) and ancient (प्रत्नासः (*pratnāsaḥ*)), having duly (यथा (*yathā*)) attained (आशुषाणाः (*āśuṣāṇāḥ*)) the true sacrifice (ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)), went to the bright place (शुचि (*śuci*), "shining"). In the same way they came to radiance (दीधितिं (*dīdhitiṃ*), "lustre"). Moreover, being reciters of the recited śastras (उक्तशासः (*uktaśāsaḥ*)), and splitting the darkness (क्षाम (*kṣāma*), "the cause of decay"), that is sin, the Aṅgirases uncovered the ruddy (अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*), "red-coloured") cows carried off by the Paṇis, and the dawns (गा उषसो ना (*gā uṣaso nā*))." अप व्रन् (*apa vran*) means "they opened", that is, they made them manifest.[?366]

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni!

- अध (*adha*)—and
- परासः (*parāsaḥ*)—excellent
- प्रत्नासः (*pratnāsaḥ*)—ancient
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- पितरः (*pitaraḥ*)—fathers, the Aṅgirases
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—the sacrifice, which is true
- यथा (*yathā*)—as prescribed
- आशुषाणाः (*āśuṣāṇāḥ*)—having accomplished
- शुचि (*śuci*)—the shining place
- अयन् (*ayan*)—reached
- दीधितिं (*dīdhitiṃ*)—also obtained lustre
- उक्तशासनः (*uktaśāsanaḥ*)—reciting the śastra-mantras[?367]
- क्षाम (*kṣāma*)—the darkness
- भिंदंतः (*bhiṃdaṃtaḥ*)—splitting
- अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*)—the golden-hued cows
- अप व्रन् (*apa vran*)—made them shine (made them visible)

Gist

O Agni, our fathers the Aṅgirases, excellent and ancient, duly performed the true sacrifice and reached the shining place. They themselves also became full of brilliance. Reciting the śastra-mantras and splitting the darkness, they made the golden-hued cows shine forth (become visible).

English translation

Thus, Agni, our excellent and ancient forefathers, celebrators of holy sacrifice, proceeded to (the region of) pure light, and, reciting prayers and dispersing gloom, they made manifest the purple (cows).

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सु॒कर्मा॑णः सु॒रुचो॑ देव॒यन्तोऽयो॒ न दे॒वा जनि॑मा॒ धम॑न्तः ।
शु॒चन्तो॑ अ॒ग्निं व॑वृ॒धन्त॒ इन्द्र॑मू॒र्वं गव्यं॑ परि॒षद॑न्तो अग्मन् ॥ १७ ॥

> *sukarmāṇaḥ suruco devayanto 'yo na devā janimā dhamantaḥ |*
> *śucanto agniṃ vavṛdhanta indramūrvaṃ gavyaṃ pariṣadanto agman ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सुकर्माणः । सुरुचः । देवयंतः । अयः । न । देवाः । जनिम । धमंतः ।
> शुचंतः । अग्निं । ववृधंतः । इंद्रं । ऊर्वं । गव्यं । परिषदंतः । अग्मन् ॥ १७ ॥

> *sukarmāṇaḥ | surucaḥ | devayaṃtaḥ | ayaḥ | na | devāḥ | janima | dhamaṃtaḥ |*
> *śucaṃtaḥ | agniṃ | vavṛdhaṃtaḥ | iṃdraṃ | ūrvaṃ | gavyaṃ | pariṣadaṃtaḥ | agman ‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आग्रयण आग्नेंद्रस्य हविषः सुकर्माण इति याज्या । सूत्रितं च । सुकर्माणः सुरुचो देवयंतो विश्वे देवास आ गत । आ. २–९ । इति ॥
> सुकर्माणः सुष्पनुष्ठितयागादिकर्माणः सुरुचः शोभनदीप्तयो देवयंतो देवान् कामयमाना देवा देवनशीलाः स्तोतारो जनिम स्वकीयं
> मानुषं जन्म धमंतो यागादिलक्षणेन कर्मणा निर्मलीकुर्वंतः । तत्र दृष्टांतः।
> अयो न । यथा कर्मारा अयो भस्त्रेण धमंति तद्वत् । तादृशा अग्निं शुचंतो
> हविर्भिर्दिर्पयंत इंद्रं ववृधंतः सोमेन स्तुत्या वा वधयंतोंगिरसः
> परिषदंतः परितः सीदंतः संत ऊर्वं महांतं गव्यं गोसंघमग्मन् । प्राप्पुवन् ॥ सुकर्माणः ।
> सोर्मनसीत्युत्तरपदाद्युदात्तत्वं । धमंतः । ध्मा शब्दाग्निसंयोगयोः । शतरि पाघ्रादिना धमादेशः
> शपः पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे शतुर्लसार्वधातुकस्वरः । ववृधंतः । वृधु वर्धने । व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं ।

> शतरि शपः श्लुः ।
> गव्यं । गवां समूह इत्यर्थे खलगोरथादिति यः । अगम् । गमर्लुजि ज्लेर्लुकि
> रूपं ॥

> *āgrayaṇa āgneṃdrasya haviṣaḥ sukarmāṇa iti yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *sukarmāṇaḥ suruco devayaṃto viśve devāsa ā gata | ā. 2-9 | iti ‖*
> *sukarmāṇaḥ suṣpanuṣṭhitayāgādikarmāṇaḥ surucaḥ śobhanadīptayo*
> *devayaṃto devān kāmayamānā devā devanaśīlāḥ stotāro janima*
> *svakīyaṃ*
> *mānuṣaṃ janma dhamaṃto yāgādilakṣaṇena karmaṇā*
> *nirmalīkurvaṃtaḥ | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ|*
> *ayo na | yathā karmārā ayo bhastreṇa dhamaṃti tadvat | tādṛśā agniṃ*
> *śucaṃto*
> *havirbhirdirpayaṃta iṃdraṃ vavṛdhaṃtaḥ somena stutyā vā*
> *vadhayaṃtoṃgirasaḥ*
> *pariṣadaṃtaḥ paritaḥ sīdaṃtaḥ saṃta ūrvaṃ mahāṃtaṃ gavyaṃ*
> *gosaṃghamagman | prāppuvan ‖ sukarmāṇaḥ |*
> *sormanasītyuttarapadādyudāttatvaṃ | dhamaṃtaḥ | dhmā*
> *śabdāgnisaṃyogayoḥ | śatari pāghrādinā dhamādeśaḥ śapaḥ*
> *pittvādanudāttatve śaturlasārvadhātukasvaraḥ | vavṛdhaṃtaḥ | vṛdhu*
> *vardhane | vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ | śatari śapaḥ śluḥ |*
> *gavyaṃ | gavāṃ samūha ityarthe khalagorathāditi yaḥ | agam |*
> *gamarluji jlerluki*
> *rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

In the Āgrayaṇa, for the oblation of Agni and Indra, सुकर्माणः (*sukarmāṇaḥ*) is the yājyā verse. It is also stated in the sūtra: सुकर्माणः सुरुचो देवयंतो विश्वे देवास आ गत (*sukarmāṇaḥ suruco devayaṃto viśve devāsa ā gata*) (Ā. Sū. 2-9).

The Aṅgirases are "of good works" (सुकर्माणः (*sukarmāṇaḥ*)): their sacrifices and other rites are well performed. They are "of good lustre" (सुरुचः (*surucaḥ*)): their splendour is beautiful. They are देवयंतः (*devayaṃtaḥ*), desiring the gods. They are देवाः (*devāḥ*), the praisers, who are "of a shining nature". They purify (धमंतः (*dhamaṃtaḥ*)) their own human birth (जनिम (*janima*)) by rites such as the sacrifice. The illustration is अयो न (*ayo na*): as smiths blow iron with the bellows, so do they. Such as they are, making Agni shine (शुचंतः (*śucaṃtaḥ*)) with oblations, and increasing Indra (ववृधंतः (*vavṛdhaṃtaḥ*)) with soma or with praise, sitting around (परिषदंतः (*pariṣadaṃtaḥ*), "sitting on all sides"), they reached (अग्मन् (*agman*)) the great (ऊर्वं (*ūrvaṃ*)) herd of cows (गव्यं (*gavyaṃ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- सुकर्माणि (*sukarmāṇi*)—those who perform excellent works
- सुरुचः (*surucaḥ*)—of excellent radiance
- देवयंतः (*devayaṃtaḥ*)—desiring godhood
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—the Aṅgirases, of divine nature
- अयो न (*ayo na*)—as a smith refines iron in his furnace
- जनिम (*janima*)—their human birth
- धमंतः (*dhamaṃtaḥ*)—made it refined by rites such as the sacrifice (and)
- अग्निं (*agniṃ*)—Agni
- शुचंतः (*śucaṃtaḥ*)—making shine
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- ववृधंतः (*vavṛdhaṃtaḥ*)—making him grow strong by praises
- परिषदंतः (*pariṣadaṃtaḥ*)—searching on all sides
- ऊर्वं (*ūrvaṃ*)—great
- गव्यं (*gavyaṃ*)—wealth of cattle
- अग्मन् (*agman*)—obtained

Gist

The Aṅgirases, excellent performers of rites, of splendid radiance, desiring godhood and divine in nature, refined their human birth by rites such as the sacrifice, as a smith refines iron in his furnace. And making Agni shine, making Indra grow strong by praises, and searching on all sides, they obtained great wealth of cattle.

English translation

Performers of good works, brilliant and devout, the praises of the gods have freed their birth from impurity, as (a smith heats) iron : exciting Agni, elevating Indra, and wandering about (in search), they have gone to the vast (hidden) herd of cattle.

Special Topics

In the Āgrayaṇa-iṣṭi, in the oblation-offering made to the deities Agni and Indra, this Ṛk सुकर्माणः (*sukarmāṇaḥ*) is to be recited as the yājyā mantra. This is set out by the Āśvalāyana-śrautasūtra, in the sūtra सुकर्माइः सुरुचो देवयंतो विश्वे देवास आ गत (*sukarmāiḥ suruco devayaṃto viśve devāsa ā gata*) (Ā. Sū. 2-9).

Ṛk 18

Samhitā-pāṭha

आ यू॒थेव॑ क्षु॒मति॑ प॒श्वो अ॑ख्यद्दे॒वानां॒ यज्जनि॒मान्त्यु॑ग्र ।
मर्ता॑नां चिदु॒र्वशी॑रकृप्रन्वृ॒धे चि॑द॒र्य उप॑रस्या॒योः ॥ १८ ॥

> *ā yūtheva kṣumati paśvo akhyaddevānāṃ yajjanimāntyugra |*
> *martānāṃ cidurvaśīrakṛpranvṛdhe cidarya uparasyāyoḥ ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । यूथाइव । क्षुमति । पश्वः । अख्यत् । देवानां । यत् । जनिम । अंति ।
> उग्र ।
> मर्तानां । चित् । उर्वशीः । अकृप्रन् । वृधे । चित् । अर्यः । उपरस्य । आयोः ॥

> *ā | yūthāiva | kṣumati | paśvaḥ | akhyat | devānāṃ | yat | janima |*
> *aṃti |*
> *ugra |*
> *martānāṃ | cit | urvaśīḥ | akṛpran | vṛdhe | cit | aryaḥ | uparasya |*
> *āyoḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उग्र तेजस्विन्ने अग्ने देवानामंगिरसां संबंधि यज्जनिम यं गोसंघमंति पर्वतस्य समीप आख्यत् । आ समंतादिंद्रोऽपश्यत् । तत्र दृष्टांतः ।
> यूथेव । यथा पश्वः पशूनां गवां यूथानि क्षुमत्यन्नवत्याढ्यगृहे वर्तमानानि
> पश्यंति जनास्तद्वत् । यद्वा । हे अग्ने तव परिचारकोऽंगिरोगणो देवानामिंद्रादीनां यज्ञनिम योऽयं जनोऽंति मदंतिके पश्वः पणिभिरपहृतान्वशूनाख्यत् । समंतात्पश्यति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । यथा क्षुमति शब्दं कुर्वाणे गवां
> यूथा यूथे पशून्त्यंति तद्वत् । मर्तानां चिन्मनुष्याणामुर्वशीरूरुभ्यामश्नुवानाः । उर्वभ्यश्नुत ऊरुभ्यामश्नुत इति यास्कः । नि. ५–१६। प्रजा अकृप्रन् ।
> ताभिरानीताभिर्गोभिः कृप्ता: समर्था अभवन् । चिदपि च अर्यः स्वामी लब्धगोधन
> उपरस्कोप्तस्य निषिक्तस्यापत्यस्य वृधे वर्धनाय समर्थो भवति । तथायोर्मनुष्यस्य भृत्यादेश पोषणे समर्थो भवति ॥ यूथेव । शसः सप्तम्या ना
> डादेशः । क्षुमति । क्षुदित्यन्ननाम । यद्वा । टुक्षु शब्दे । भावे क्विप् । छांदसस्तकारलोपः । तदस्यास्तीति मतुप् । हस्त्रनुड्भ्यां मतुबिति मतुप उदात्तत्वं ।
> अख्यत् । ख्या प्रकथने । लुजु चेरस्यतिवक्तिख्यातिभ्योऽङ्ज्ञात्यजादेशः। आतो लोपः।
> जनिम । जनी प्रादुर्भावे । हृजनिभ्यामिमनिन्नि तीमनिन्नत्ययः । नित्त्वादाम्युदात्तः । अकृप्रन् । कृपू सामर्थ्ये । लजु बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । रुडागमः ॥

> *ugra tejasvinne agne devānāmamṃgirasāṃ saṃbaṃdhi yajjanima yaṃ gosaṃghamaṃti parvatasya samīpa ākhyat | ā samaṃtādiṃdro 'paśyat | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *yūtheva | yathā paśvaḥ paśūnāṃ gavāṃ yūthāni kṣumatyannavatyāḍhyagṛhe vartamānāni*
> *paśyaṃti janāstadvat | yadvā | he agne tava paricārako 'ṃgirogaṇo devānāmiṃdrādīnāṃ yajñanima yo 'yaṃ jano 'ṃti madaṃtike paśvaḥ paṇibhirapahṛtānvaśūnākhyat | samaṃtātpaśyati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | yathā kṣumati śabdaṃ kurvāṇe gavāṃ*
> *yūthā yūthe paśūntyaṃti tadvat | martānāṃ cinmanuṣyāṇāmurvaśīrūrubhyāmaśnuvānāḥ | urvabhyaśnuta ūrubhyāmaśnuta iti yāskaḥ | ni. 5-16| prajā akṛpran |*
> *tābhirānītābhirgobhiḥ kṛptā: samarthā abhavan | cidapi ca aryaḥ svāmī labdhagodhana uparaskoptasya niṣiktasyāpatyasya vṛdhe vardhanāya samartho bhavati | tathāyormanuṣyasya bhṛtyādeśa poṣaṇe samartho bhavati ‖ yūtheva | śasaḥ saptamyā nā*
> *ḍādeśaḥ | kṣumati | kṣudityannanāma | yadvā | ṭukṣu śabde | bhāve kvip | chāṃdasastakāralopaḥ | tadasyāstīti matup | hasranuḍbhyāṃ*

> *matubiti matupa udāttatvaṃ |*
> *akhyat | khyā prakathane | luju cerasyativaktikhyātibhyo 'jjātyajādeśaḥ |*
> *āto lopaḥ |*
> *janima | janī prādurbhāve | hṛjanibhyāmimaninni tīmaninnatyayaḥ |*
> *nittvādāmyudāttaḥ | akṛpran | kṛpū sāmarthye | laju bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk | ruḍāgamaḥ ||*

Summary

"O fierce (उग्र (*ugra*)), radiant Agni, the herd of cows belonging to the gods, the Aṅgirases, which (यत् जनिम (*yat janima*)) near (अंति (*aṃti*)) the mountain Indra beheld (आ अख्यत् (*ā akhyat*)) on all sides." The illustration is यूथेव (*yūtheva*): as people see herds of cattle, of cows, living in the house of a rich man who has plenty of food (क्षुमति (*kṣumati*)).

Or else: "O Agni, your attendant band of Aṅgirases sees all around the cattle of the gods, Indra and the others, carried off by the Paṇis, which this person is near me (अंति (*aṃti*))." The illustration: as, when the herd of cows is making a noise, people see the cattle in the herd.

मर्तानां चित् (*martānāṃ cit*): of mortals, men; उर्वशीः (*urvaśīḥ*) are those who pervade with the thighs. Sāyaṇa quotes Yāska: उर्वभ्यश्नुत ऊरुभ्यामश्नुत इति यास्कः (*urvabhyaśnuta ūrubhyāmaśnuta iti yāskaḥ*) (Ni. 5-16).[?368] The progeny (प्रजा (*prajā*)) became able (अकृप्रन् (*akṛpran*)), that is, competent, through the cows brought by them. Moreover the master (अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)) who has obtained the wealth of cattle becomes able for the growth (वृधे (*vṛdhe*)) of the offspring sown (उपरस्य (*uparasya*)), and in the same way he is able for the nourishing of men, dependents and so on (आयोः (*āyoḥ*)).[?369]

Word-to-word meaning

- उग्र (*ugra*)—O radiant Agni
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—belonging to the Aṅgirā seers
- यत् जनिम (*yat janima*)—which herd of cows
- अंति (*aṃti*)—near the mountain
- यूथेव पश्वः (*yūtheva paśvaḥ*)—as people see a herd of cattle
- क्षुमति (*kṣumati*)—in a house provided with wealth of food

- आ अख्यत् (*ā akhyat*)—Indra saw all around. [Or else]
- हे उग्र (*he ugra*)—O Agni!
- अंगिरोगणः (*aṃgirogaṇaḥ*)—the company of Aṅgirā seers who serve you
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—belonging to the gods, Indra and the others
- पश्वः (*paśvaḥ*)—carried off by the asuras called Paṇis
- क्षुमति (*kṣumati*)—lowing
- यूथेव (*yūtheva*)—like a herd of cows
- यज्ञनिम (*yajñanima*)—as people see it, near
- अंति (*aṃti*)—near
- आ अख्यत् (*ā akhyat*)—Indra saw all around
- मर्तानां चित् (*martānāṃ cit*)—belonging to men
- उर्वशीः (*urvaśīḥ*)—the cows
- अकृपन् (*akṛpan*)—became able to obtain
- चित् (*cit*)—and
- अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)—the master, the householder who has obtained cows
- उपरस्य (*uparasya*)—excellent works
- वृधे (*vṛdhe*)—becomes able to increase
- आयोः (*āyoḥ*)—(and) becomes able also to nourish men, that is, dependents and the like

Gist

O radiant Agni, as one sees the cows in the cattle-shed of a house abounding in food, so Indra saw all around the cows of the Aṅgirā seers carried off by the Paṇis. Or else: as people see well-nourished cattle in a house provided with wealth of food, so Indra saw the cows of the Aṅgirā seers carried off by the Paṇis. The master of the house who has obtained the herd of cows performs excellent works and becomes able to nourish his dependents, sons, grandsons and the rest.

English translation

Fierce (Agni), when (Indra) proclaimed the near presence of the herd of the cows of the divine (Angirasas) as a herd of cattle in a well-stored stall, the progeny of mortals were thereby enabled (to perform pious acts) and the master of the family rendered competent to (provide for) the increase of posterity and (the support of) dependents

Special Topics

The meaning of this Ṛk is not clear. The commentator's explanation too is not lucid, and the seer's intention cannot be known. The commentator has explained the word जनिम (*janima*) as a herd of cows and the word उर्वशीः (*urvaśīḥ*) as progeny; yet it has not been possible to fit a definite meaning to this Ṛk. The scholar Wilson has explained it thus:

आ यूथेव क्षुमति पश्वः अख्यत् (*ā yūtheva kṣumati paśvaḥ akhyat*) देवानां यत् जनिम अंति (*devānāṃ yat janima aṃti*)—The expression literally means, like a herd in food-possessing animals; he had said of the gods that which birth is nigh ; Sayana interprets जनिम (*janima*) as गोसंघं (*gosaṃghaṃ*) and makes out the rest as above, or he proposes an alternative, not more intelligible; the second half of the stanza is equally obscure as the first. मर्तानां चित् उर्वशीः अकृप्रन् (*martānāṃ cit urvaśīḥ akṛpran*) वृधे चित् अर्यः उपरस्य आयोः (*vṛdhe cit aryaḥ uparasya āyoḥ*), उर्वशीः (*urvaśīḥ*) is rendered by Sayana प्रजा (*prajā*) progeny, as if it was the nominative instead of being the accusative plural ; and if so, there is no nominative to अकृप्रन् (*akṛpran*) were made able ; the word is remarkable, and is made more so by Sayana's reference to Yaska निरुक्त (*nirukta*). 5-1 where the word means, as usual अप्सराः (*apsarāḥ*) and the etymology is ऊरुभ्यामश्नुते (*ūrubhyāmaśnute*) who pervades or proceeds from the thigh. conformably to the Pauranik legend of her birth from the thigh of Narayana. See also the विक्रमोर्वशीय (*vikramorvaśīya*) of काळिदास (*kāḷidāsa*) which shows the legend to be of some antiquity.

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अक॑र्म ते॒ स्वप॑सो अभूम ऋ॒तम॑वस्रन्नु॒षसो॑ विभा॒तीः ।

अनू॑नम॒ग्निं पु॑रु॒धा सु॑श्च॒न्द्रं दे॒वस्य॒ मर्मृ॑जत॒श्चारु॒ चक्षु॑ः ॥ १९ ॥

> *akarma te svapaso abhūma ṛtamavasrannuṣaso vibhātīḥ |*
> *anūnamagniṃ purudhā suścandraṃ devasya marmṛjataścāru cakṣuḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अकर्म । ते । सुअपसः । अभूम । ऋतं । अवस्रन् । उषसः । विभातीः ।
> अनूनं । अग्निं । पुरुधा । सुचंद्रं । देवस्य । मर्मृजतः । चारु । चक्षुः ॥ १९ ॥

> *akarma | te | suapasaḥ | abhūma | ṛtaṃ | avasran | uṣasaḥ | vibhātīḥ |*
> *anūnaṃ | agniṃ | purudhā | sucaṃdraṃ | devasya | marmṛjataḥ | cāru | cakṣuḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ते तव परिचरणमकर्म । कुर्मः । तेन कर्मणा स्वपसः शोभनकर्माणोऽभूम ।
> विभातीर्व्युच्छंत्य उषस ऋतं तेजोऽवस्रन् । आच्छादयंति ।
> धारयंतीत्यर्थः । तथा ता उषसोऽनूनं संपूर्णं पुरुधा बहुधा सुश्चंद्रं
> सुष्ठाह्लादकारिणं यद्वा सुहिरण्यमग्निं धारयंति । किंच देवस्य द्योतमानस्य
> तव चारु मनोहरं चक्षुस्तेजो मर्मृजतः परिचरंतो वयं स्वपसोऽभूमेति पूर्वेणान्वयः ॥ अकर्म ।
> करोतेर्लजु बहुलु छंधसीति विकरणस्य लुक् ।
> मर्मुजतः । मृजूष् शुद्धौ । यज्लुकि रुग्रिकौ च लुकीत्यभ्यासस्य रुगागमः ।
> शतरि नाभ्यस्ताच्छतुरिति नुमभावः । अभ्यस्तस्वरः ॥

> *he agne te tava paricaraṇamakarma | kurmaḥ | tena karmaṇā svapasaḥ*
> *śobhanakarmāṇo 'bhūma | vibhātīrvucchaṃtya uṣasa ṛtaṃ tejo 'vasran |*
> *ācchādayaṃti |*
> *dhārayaṃtītyarthaḥ | tathā tā uṣaso 'nūnaṃ saṃpūrṇaṃ purudhā*

> *bahudhā suścaṃdraṃ*
> *suṣṭhāhlādakāriṇaṃ yadvā suhiraṇyamagniṃ dhārayaṃti | kiṃca devasya dyotamānasya*
> *tava cāru manoharaṃ cakṣustejo marmṛjataḥ paricaraṃto vayaṃ svapaso 'bhūmeti pūrveṇānvayaḥ || akarma | karoterlaju bahulu chaṃdhasīti vikaraṇasya luk |*
> *marmujataḥ | mṛjūṣ śuddhau | yajluki rugrikau ca lukītyabhyāsasya rugāgamaḥ |*
> *śatari nābhyastācchaturiti numabhāvaḥ | abhyastasvaraḥ ||*

Summary

"O Agni, we have done (अकर्म (*akarma*), "we do") service to you; by that work we have become (अभूम (*abhūma*)) of good works (स्वपसः (*svapasaḥ*)). The shining dawns (विभातीः (*vibhātīḥ*)), as they break forth, cover or bear (अवस्रन् (*avasran*)) the light (ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*), "brightness"), that is, they hold it. In the same way those dawns bear Agni, who is complete (अनूनं (*anūnaṃ*)), in many ways (पुरुधा (*purudhā*)), and who gives excellent delight (सुश्चंद्रं (*suścaṃdraṃ*)), or else is of good gold." Further, serving (मर्मृजतः (*marmṛjataḥ*)) the lovely (चारु (*cāru*)), charming eye, the lustre (चक्षुः (*cakṣuḥ*)), of you, the shining god (देवस्य (*devasya*)), we have become of good works. The construction is with the preceding words.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Agni) विभातीः (*vibhātīḥ*)—shining
- उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*)—of the dawn
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—the lustre
- अवस्रन् (*avasran*)—spread out (and)
- अनूनं (*anūnaṃ*)—that which is full and complete, without deficiency
- पुरुधा (*purudhā*)—in many ways
- सुश्चंद्रं (*suścaṃdraṃ*)—and that which gives delight
- अग्निं (*agniṃ*)—the lustre of Agni (it bears)
- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of you, the shining one
- चारु (*cāru*)—beautiful
- चक्षुः (*cakṣuḥ*)—the lustre

- मर्मृजतः (*marmṛjataḥ*)—serving
- ते (*te*)—your worship
- अकर्म (*akarma*)—we perform (and therefore)
- स्वपसः (*svapasaḥ*)—as possessors of excellent work
- अभूम (*abhūma*)—we become

Gist

O Agni, the lustre of the shining dawn spreads everywhere, and it bears the lustre of Agni, which is full and delights in many ways. Serving your beautiful, shining lustre, we perform your worship; and therefore we become possessors of excellent work.

English translation

We have worshipped you (Agni), and have thereby become the performers of a good work, adoring the full and variously delighting Agni, the beautiful lustre of the radiant divinity, when the brilliant dawns have arrayed (themselves) in light.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒ता ते॑ अग्न उ॒चथा॑नि वे॒धोऽवो॑चाम क॒वये॒ ता जु॑षस्व ।
उच्छो॑चस्व कृणु॒हि वस्य॑सो नो म॒हो रा॒यः पु॑रुवार॒ प्र यं॑न्धि ॥ २० ॥

> *etā te agna ucathāni vedho 'vocāma kavaye tā juṣasva |*
> *ucchocasva kṛṇuhi vasyaso no maho rāyaḥ puruvāra pra yandhi ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एता । ते। अग्ने। उचथानि । वेधः । अवोचाम । कवये । ता । जुषस्व ।
> उत् । शोचस्व । कृणुहि । वस्यसः । नः।महः । रायः । पुरुरुवार । प्र । यंधि ॥२०॥

> *etā | te| agne| ucathāni | vedhaḥ | avocāma | kavaye | tā | juṣasva |*
> *ut | śocasva | kṛṇuhi | vasyasaḥ | naḥ|mahaḥ | rāyaḥ | pururuvāra |*
> *pra | yaṃdhi ‖20‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वेधो विधातर्हे अग्ने कवये मेधाविने ते तुभ्यमेतैतान्युचथान्युक्थानि
> शस्त्राण्यवोचाम । त्वं ता तानि जुषस्व । सेवस्व । किंच त्वमुच्छोचस्व । उद्दीप्यस्व ।
> नोऽस्मान्वस्यसोऽतिशयेन धनयुक्तान् कृणुहि । कुरु । तदेवोच्यते । पुरुवार
> पुरुभिर्बहुभिर्वर्णीय महो रायो महद्धनं प्र यंधि । अस्मभ्यं प्रयच्छ ॥
> अवोचाम । वच परिभाषणे । लुजि क्लेरजादेशः । पादादित्वादनिघातः । कृणुहि ।
> कृवि हिंसाकरणयोरित्यस्य लोटि रूपं । तिज उत्तरत्वादनिघातः । वस्यसः ।
> वसुमच्छब्दादीयसुनि विन्मतोर्लुगिति मतुपो लुकि टिलोपे च कृत ईकारलोपश्छांदसः । यंधि
> । यमेर्लोटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । वा छंदसीति
> हेर्विकल्पेन पित्त्वादजुतश्चति धिरादेशः ॥

> *vedho vidhātarhe agne kavaye medhāvine te*
> *tubhyametaitānyucathānyukthāni*
> *śastrāṇyavocāma | tvaṃ tā tāni juṣasva | sevasva | kiṃca*
> *tvamucchocasva | uddīpyasva |*
> *no 'smānvasyaso 'tiśayena dhanayuktān kṛṇuhi | kuru | tadevocyate |*
> *puruvāra*
> *purubhirbahubhirvarṇīya maho rāyo mahaddhanaṃ pra yaṃdhi |*
> *asmabhyaṃ prayaccha ‖*
> *avocāma | vaca paribhāṣaṇe | luji klerajādeśaḥ | pādāditvādanighātaḥ |*
> *kṛṇuhi |*
> *kṛvi hiṃsākaraṇayorityasya loṭi rūpaṃ | tija uttaratvādanighātaḥ |*
> *vasyasaḥ | vasumacchabdādīyasuni vinmatorlugiti matupo luki ṭilope ca*
> *kṛta īkāralopaśrāṃdasaḥ | yaṃdhi | yamerloṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti*
> *vikaraṇasya luk | vā chaṃdasīti*
> *hervikalpena pittvādajutaścati dhirādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

O creator (vedhas), O Agni, to you the wise (kavi) we have recited these praises (ukthas, i.e. śastras). Accept them, take pleasure in them. Moreover blaze up; make us exceedingly rich in wealth. That is what is said: O Purūvāra, you who are to be chosen by many,

bestow on us great wealth (mahaḥ rāyaḥ, "ample wealth"). The remainder of the block is grammar: the forms avocāma, kṛṇuhi, vasyasaḥ, yandhi.

Word-to-word meaning

- वेधः (*vedhaḥ*)—O creator
- अग्ने (*agne*)—Agni
- कवये (*kavaye*)—the wise one
- ते (*te*)—addressing you
- एता उक्तानि (*etā uktāni*)—these śastra-mantras
- अवोचाम (*avocāma*)—we recite
- ता (*tā*)—them
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—accept
- उच्चोचस्व (*uccocasva*)—shine excellently
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- वस्यसः (*vasyasaḥ*)—as possessors of wealth
- कृणुहि (*kṛṇuhi*)—make
- पुरुवार (*puruvāra*)—O Agni, desired by many
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—abundant
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—wealth
- प्र यंधि (*pra yaṃdhi*)—give to us

Gist

O Agni, the creator, we recite these śastra-mantras addressed to you, the wise one. Accept them. Shine excellently. Make us possessors of wealth. O Agni, desired by many, give us abundant wealth.

English translation

Creator, Agni, we have repeated these your praises to you who are all-wise ; do you accept them : blaze aloft ; make us opulent: you are worshipped by many ; bestow upon us ample wealth.

Sūkta 3 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> आ वो राजानमिति षोडशर्चं तृतीयं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभमाग्नेयं । आ वः षोळशेत्यनुक्रांतं
> ॥ प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोर्विनियोग
> उक्तः ॥
> अनुवादवु—आ वो राजानं ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि मूरनॆय
> सूक्तवु. इदरल्लि हदिनारु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु
> देवतॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि आ वः षोळश ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. प्रातर
> नुवाक मत्तु अश्विनशस्त्रमंत्रपठनक्कागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु हिंदॆये हेळलागिदॆ.
> ॥ ओं ॥
> सूक्त—३
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—३ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—२०, २१, २२ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—१६ ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—अग्निः ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *ā vo rājānamiti ṣoḍaśarcaṃ tṛtīyaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ*
> *traiṣṭubhamāgneyaṃ | ā vaḥ ṣoḷaśetyanukrāṃtaṃ ‖*
> *prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayorviniyoga*
> *uktaḥ ‖*
> *anuvādavu—ā vo rājānaṃ èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèya anuvākadalli mūranèya*
> *sūktavu. idaralli hadināru ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu*
> *devatèyu ; triṣṭup chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli ā vaḥ ṣoḷaśa èṃdu heḷiruvudu. prātara*
> *nuvāka mattu aśvinaśastramaṃtrapaṭhanakkāgi ī sūktada viniyogaviruvudèṃdu hiṃdèye heḷalāgidè.*
> *‖ oṃ ‖*
> *sūkta—3*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—3 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—20, 21, 22 ‖*

> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—16 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agniḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The third sūkta, आ वो राजानं (*ā vo rājānaṃ*), has sixteen ṛks; its seer is Vāmadeva, its deity Agni, its metre Triṣṭubh; the Anukramaṇī says आ वः षोळश (*ā vaḥ ṣoḷaśa*). Its use (viniyoga) in the Prātaranuvāka and in the Aśvina-śastra has been stated before. The Kannada Anuvāda adds that this is the third sūkta of the first anuvāka. The particulars given: Maṇḍala 4; Anuvāka 1; Sūkta 3; Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 4; Vargas 20, 21, 22; number of ṛks in the sūkta 16; Ṛṣi Vāmadeva; Devatā Agni; Chandas Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ वो॒ राजा॑नमध्व॒रस्य॑ रु॒द्रं होता॑रं सत्य॒यजं॒ रोद॑स्योः ।
अ॒ग्निं पु॒रा त॑नयि॒त्नोर॒चित्ता॒द्धिर॑ण्यरूप॒मव॑से कृणुध्वम् ॥ १ ॥

> *ā vo rājānamadhvarasya rudraṃ hotāraṃ satyayajaṃ rodasyoḥ |*
> *agniṃ purā tanayitnoracittāddhiraṇyarūpamavase kṛṇudhvam ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । वः । राजानं । अध्वरस्य । रुद्रं । होतारं । सत्ययजं । रोदस्कोः ।
> अग्निं । पुरा । तनयित्नोः । अचित्तात् । हिरण्यरूपं । अवसे । कृणुध्वं ॥ १ ॥

> *ā | vaḥ | rājānaṃ | adhvarasya | rudraṃ | hotāraṃ | satyayajaṃ | rodaskoḥ |*
> *agniṃ | purā | tanayitnoḥ | acittāt | hiraṇyarūpaṃ | avase | kṛṇudhvaṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋत्विग्यजमाना अध्वरस्य यज्ञस्य राजानमधिपतिं होतारं देवानामाह्वातारं रुद्रं रोरूयमाणं
> द्रवंतं शत्रून्रोदयंतं वा । यद्वा ।
> एषा ना अग्नेस्तनूर्यद्रुद्र इति रुद्रात्मकं रोदस्योर्द्यानापृथिव्योः सत्ययजं
> सत्यस्यान्नस्य दातारं । यद्वा । सत्ययजं सत्येन हविषा देवान्यजंतं । यद्वा ।
> रोदस्योर्वाप्य वर्तमानं हिरण्यरूपं सुवर्णप्रभं । एवंविधमग्निं वो
> युष्माकमवसे रक्षणाय तनयित्नोः । तनयित्नुरशनिः स ह्याकस्मिकः । तत्सदृशादचित्तात् ।
> न विद्यते चित्तं यस्मिन् तदचित्तं । चित्तोपलक्षितसर्वेंद्रियोपसंहारो
> मरणमिति यावत् । तस्मान्मरणात्पुरा प्रागेवा कृणुध्वं । यूयं समंताद्दपिर्भिरग्निं भजध्वं ॥ रुद्रं
> । रोदयते रोदेर्णिलुक्च ! उ. २–२२ । इति रक्षत्ययः । तनयित्नोः । तनिः शब्दार्थः ।
> चुरादिरदंतः । स्तनिशुधिपुषिगमिमनिभ्यो
> णेरित्तुच् । उ. ३–२९ । इतीत्नुच् प्रत्ययः । चित्स्वरेणांतोदात्तः । सुपा सहैकादेश
> एकादेशस्वरः । कृणुध्वं । कृवि हिंसाकरणयोः । लोटि रूपं ॥

> *he ṛtvigyajamānā adhvarasya yajñasya rājānamadhipatiṃ hotāraṃ devānāmāhvātāraṃ rudraṃ rorūyamāṇaṃ dravaṃtaṃ śatrūnrodayaṃtaṃ vā | yadvā |*
> *eṣā nā agnestanūryadrudra iti rudrātmakaṃ rodasyordyānāpṛthivyoḥ satyayajaṃ*
> *satyasyānnasya dātāraṃ | yadvā | satyayajaṃ satyena haviṣā devānyajaṃtaṃ | yadvā |*
> *rodasyorvāpya vartamānaṃ hiraṇyarūpaṃ suvarṇaprabhaṃ | evaṃvidhamagniṃ vo*
> *yuṣmākamavase rakṣaṇāya tanayitnoḥ | tanayitnuraśaniḥ sa hyākasmikaḥ | tatsadṛśādacittāt | na vidyate cittaṃ yasmin tadacittaṃ | cittopalakṣitasarveṃdriyopasaṃhāro*
> *maraṇamiti yāvat | tasmānmaraṇātpurā prāgevā kṛṇudhvaṃ | yūyaṃ samaṃtāddapirbhiragniṃ bhajadhvaṃ ‖ rudraṃ | rodayate roderṇilukca ! u. 2-22 | iti rakṣatyayaḥ | tanayitnoḥ | taniḥ śabdārthaḥ | curādiradaṃtaḥ | staniśudhipuṣigamimanibhyo*
> *ṇerittuc | u. 3-29 | itītnuc pratyayaḥ | citsvareṇāṃtodāttaḥ | supā sahaikādeśa ekādeśasvaraḥ | kṛṇudhvaṃ | kṛvi hiṃsākaraṇayoḥ | loṭi rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

O priests and sacrificers, make Agni yours for protection: the king (lord) of the sacrifice (adhvara), the invoker (hotṛ) of the gods, Rudra — "the roaring one", or "the one who runs", or "the one who makes enemies weep". Alternatively, with the text एषा ना अग्नेस्तनूर्यद्रुद्र (*eṣā nā agnestanūryadrudra*), he is of Rudra's nature. He is the satyayaj of the two worlds (rodasī, heaven and earth): the giver of true food (satya); or the one who sacrifices to the gods with true oblation. Or again, abiding in the two worlds, he is golden-formed, of golden radiance. Such an Agni you should serve, for your protection, before (purā) the unthinking (acitta) one like the thunderbolt (tanayitnu). Tanayitnu is the lightning-bolt, which is sudden; like it is acitta, "that in which there is no thought" — the withdrawal of all the senses marked by thought, that is, death. Before that death, he says, honour Agni on all sides with oblations. The rest of the block is grammar (rudra, tanayitnoḥ, kṛṇudhvam, with Uṇ. Sū. 2-22 and 3-29).

Word-to-word meaning

- (O priests and sacrificers) अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)—of the sacrifice
- राजानं (*rājānaṃ*)—the lord
- होतारं (*hotāraṃ*)—the caller of the gods
- रुद्रं (*rudraṃ*)—the terrible to enemies
- रोदस्कोः (*rodaskoḥ*)—to both heaven and earth
- सत्ययजं (*satyayajaṃ*)—the giver of true food
- हिरण्यरूपं (*hiraṇyarūpaṃ*)—possessing a golden radiance
- अग्निं (*agniṃ*)—Agni
- वः (*vaḥ*)—your
- अवसे (*avase*)—for protection
- तनयित्नोः (*tanayitnoḥ*)—sudden like lightning
- अचित्तात् (*acittāt*)—than death
- पुरा (*purā*)—before
- आ कृणुध्वं (*ā kṛṇudhvaṃ*)—worship and serve

Gist

O priests and sacrificers, for your protection, before a death as sudden as lightning, worship and serve Agni, the lord of the sacrifice, the caller of the gods, the terrible to enemies, the giver of true food to both heaven and earth, he who has a golden radiance.

English translation

Secure Agni, the king of sacrifice, the afflicter (of foes), the invoker (of the gods), the distributor of food through heaven and earth, the golden- formed, for your protection, before (surprised by) sudden death.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं योनि॑श्चकृ॒मा यं व॒यं ते॑ जा॒येव॒ पत्य॑ उश॒ती सु॒वासाः॑ ।
अ॒र्वा॒ची॒नः परि॑वीतो॒ नि षी॑दे॒मा उ॑ ते स्वपाक प्रती॒चीः ॥ २ ॥

> *ayaṃ yoniścakṛmā yaṃ vayaṃ te jāyeva patya uśatī suvāsāḥ |*
> *arvācīnaḥ parivīto ni ṣīdemā u te svapāka pratīcīḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । योनिः । चक्रम । यं । वयं । ते । जायाइव । पत्ये । उशती । सुवासाः।
> अर्वाचीनः । परिवीतः । नि । सीद । इमाः । ऊं इति । ते । सुअपाक । प्रतीचीः ॥

> *ayaṃ | yoniḥ | cakrama | yaṃ | vayaṃ | te | jāyāiva | patye | uśatī | suvāsāḥ|*
> *arvācīnaḥ | parivītaḥ | ni | sīda | imāḥ | ūṃ iti | te | suapāka | pratīcīḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ते त्वदर्थं यमुत्तरवेदिलक्षणं प्रदेशं वयं चक्रम । कुर्मः ।
> अयं योनिस्तव स्थानं भवति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । जायेव । यथा पत्य उशती पतिं
> कामयमाना सुवासाः शोभनवस्त्रोपेता जाया स्वात्मसमीपे तस्य स्थानं
> करोति तद्वत् । हे स्वपाक स्वपस्क सुकर्मन्नग्ने त्वं परिवीतो यष्टव्यदेवैस्तेजोभिर्वा
> परिवीतोऽर्वाचीनोऽस्मदभिमुखः सन् नि षीद । उत्तरवेद्यामुपविश ।
> तत्र स्थितस्य ते तवेमा ज्वालाः स्तुतयो वा प्रतीचीस्त्वदभिमुखाः प्रवर्तंते ॥
> चक्रम । करोतेर्लिटि रूपं । वाक्यभेदान्निघाताभावः । अर्वाचीनः । विभाषांचेरदिगिति खः ।
> परिवीतः । वैञ् संवरणे । कर्मणि निष्ठा । यजादित्वात्संप्रसारणं ।
> गतिरनंतर इति गतेः स्वरः ॥

> *he agne te tvadarthaṃ yamuttaravedilakṣaṇaṃ pradeśaṃ vayaṃ cakrama | kurmaḥ |*
> *ayaṃ yonistava sthānaṃ bhavati | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | jāyeva | yathā patya uśatī patiṃ*
> *kāmayamānā suvāsāḥ śobhanavasropetā jāyā svātmasamīpe tasya sthānaṃ*
> *karoti tadvat | he svapāka svapaska sukarmannagne tvaṃ parivīto yaṣṭavyadevaistejobhirvā parivīto 'rvācīno 'smadabhimukhaḥ san ni ṣīda | uttaravedyāmupaviśa |*
> *tatra sthitasya te tavemā jvālāḥ stutayo vā pratīcīstvadabhimukhāḥ pravartaṃte ‖*
> *cakrama | karòterliṭi rūpaṃ | vākyabhedānnighātābhāvaḥ | arvācīnaḥ | vibhāṣāṃceradigiti khaḥ | parivītaḥ | vaiñ saṃvaraṇe | karmaṇi niṣṭhā | yajāditvātsaṃprasāraṇaṃ |*
> *gatiranaṃtara iti gateḥ svaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, the place (the uttaravedi) that we have made for you is your seat (yoni). The illustration: as a wife who longs for her husband (patye uśatī), well clothed, makes a place for him near herself, so too. O Svapāka, of good work, Agni, surrounded (parivīta) by the gods to be worshipped or by lustres, and turned towards us (arvācīna), sit down on the uttaravedi. While you are seated there, these flames, or these praises, move towards you (pratīcīḥ). The rest is grammar (cakrama, arvācīnaḥ, parivītaḥ).

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Agni) पत्ये उशती (*patye uśatī*)—one who longs for the nearness of her husband
- सुवासाः (*suvāsāḥ*)—adorned with excellent garments and the like
- जाया इव (*jāyā iva*)—as a wife makes a place for her husband near herself
- ते (*te*)—for you
- यं (*yaṃ*)—which uttaravedi
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- चक्रम (*cakrama*)—have constructed
- अयं योनीः (*ayaṃ yonīḥ*)—that is a sacred seat for you
- स्वपाक (*svapāka*)—O Agni of excellent work
- परिवीतः (*parivītaḥ*)—surrounded by lustres
- अर्वाचीनः (*arvācīnaḥ*)—turned towards us
- निषिद (*niṣida*)—sit down
- ते (*te*)—addressed to you
- इमाः (*imāḥ*)—these praises
- प्रतीचीः (*pratīcīḥ*)—are recited facing you

Gist

O Agni, as a wife who longs for the nearness of her husband and is adorned with excellent garments and the like makes a place for her husband near herself, so the uttaravedi that we have built for you is a sacred seat for you. O Agni of excellent work, sit down, surrounded by lustres and turned towards us. These praises addressed to you are recited facing you.

English translation

This is the altar which we have decorated for you, as a wife attached to her husband puts on elegant garments (to gratify him) : maturer of good works, sit down in our presence invested (with radiance), while your flames incline towards you.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒शृ॒ण्व॒ते अदृ॑पिताय॒ मन्म॑ नृ॒चक्ष॑से सुमृळी॒काय॑ वेधः ।
दे॒वाय॑ श॒स्तिम॒मृता॑य शंस॒ ग्रावे॑व॒ सोता॑ मधु॒षुद्यमी॒ळे ॥ ३ ॥

> *āśṛṇvate adṛpitāya manma nṛcakṣase sumṛḷīkāya vedhaḥ |*
> *devāya śastimamṛtāya śaṃsa grāveva sotā madhuṣudyamīḷe ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आशृण्वते । अदृपिताय । मन्म । नृचक्षसे । सुमृळीकाय । वेधः ।

> *āśṛṇvate | adṛpitāya | manma | nṛcakṣase | sumṛḷīkāya | vedhaḥ |*

> देवाय । शस्तिं । अमृताय । शंस । ग्रावाइव । सोता । मधुसुत् । यं ।
> ईळे । ३ ॥

> *devāya | śastiṃ | amṛtāya | śaṃsa | grāvāiva | sotā | madhusut | yaṃ |*
> *īḷe | 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वेधः स्तोत्राणां कर्तर्हे स्तोतराशृण्वते स्तोत्राकर्णनपरायादृपितायादृप्तायाप्रमत्ताय नृचक्षसे वृणां द्रष्टे सुमृळीकाय सुसुखायामृताय मरणधर्मरहिताय देवाय तस्मा अग्नये मन्म स्तोत्रं शस्तिं शस्त्रं च
> शंस । मधुषुन्मदकरस्य सोमस्य सोता । तत्र दृष्टांतः । ग्रावेव । यथा ग्रावा
> सोमस्य सोता तद्वत् । सोमाभिषवं कुर्वाणो यजमानो यमग्निमीळे ।
> स्तौति । तस्मै शंसेति समन्वयः । यद्वा । मधुषुत्सोमसुद्यजमानोंग्निमीळे ।
> स्तौति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । यथा ग्रावा सोमस्य सोता शब्दं करोति । प्रैते वदंतु
> प्र वयं वदाम ग्रावभ्यः । ऋग्वे. १०–९४–१ । इत्यत्र ग्रावां कर्तृत्वं श्रुतमिति ॥
> आशृण्वते । शतुरनुम इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । ईळे । ईड स्तुता । लट लोपस्त
> आत्मनेपदेश्विति तलोपः । यद्वा । लिटि तशब्दस्येशादेशे कृते रूपं ॥

> *vedhaḥ stotrāṇāṃ kartarhe stotarāśṛṇvate*
> *stotrākarṇanaparāyādṛpitāyādṛptāyāpramattāya nṛcakṣase vṛṇāṃ*
> *draṣṭe sumṛḷīkāya susukhāyāmṛtāya maraṇadharmarahitāya devāya*
> *tasmā agnaye manma stotraṃ śastiṃ śastraṃ ca*
> *śaṃsa | madhuṣunmadakarasya somasya sotā | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *grāveva | yathā grāvā*
> *somasya sotā tadvat | somābhiṣavaṃ kurvāṇo yajamāno yamagnimīḷe |*
> *stauti | tasmai śaṃseti samanvayaḥ | yadvā |*
> *madhuṣutsomasudyajamānoṃgnimīḷe |*
> *stauti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | yathā grāvā somasya sotā śabdaṃ karoti |*
> *praite vadaṃtu*
> *pra vayaṃ vadāma grāvabhyaḥ | ṛgve. 10-94-1 | ityatra grāvāṃ*
> *kartṛtvaṃ śrutamiti ‖*
> *āśṛṇvate | śaturanuma iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | īḷe | īḍa stutā | laṭa*
> *lopasta*
> *ātmanepadeśviti talopaḥ | yadvā | liṭi taśabdasyèśādeśe kṛte rūpaṃ ‖*

Summary

"Vedhaḥ" means O composer of hymns. Recite (शंस (*śaṃsa*)) the praise (मन्म (*manma*)) and the śastra (शस्तिं (*śastiṃ*)) to that god Agni. He is attentive to hymns (आशृण्वते (*āśṛṇvate*)), unproud and unheedless (अदृपिताय (*adṛpitāya*)), the beholder of men (नृचक्षसे (*nṛcakṣase*)), very gracious (सुमृळीकाय (*sumṛḷīkāya*)), and immortal, free from the nature of death. The sacrificer who presses the Soma (मधुषुत् (*madhuṣut*), presser of the intoxicating Soma) praises this Agni. The comparison is "like the stone": as the pressing-stone presses the Soma, so he does. The construction is: recite to him whom he praises. Or else: the Soma-presser, the sacrificer, praises Agni. The comparison is then that the pressing-stone makes a sound as it presses the Soma. Here the stones are heard as agents in प्रैते वदंतु प्र वयं वदाम ग्रावभ्यः (*praite vadaṃtu pra vayaṃ vadāma grāvabhyaḥ*) (Ṛgve. 10-94-1)[?370].

Word-to-word meaning

- वेधः (*vedhaḥ*)—O praiser
- सोता (*sotā*)—that presses the Soma

- ग्रावेव (*grāveva*)—like stones, making a sound
- मधुषुत् (*madhuṣut*)—the sacrificer who presses the sweet Soma
- यं (*yaṃ*)—which Agni
- ईळे (*īḷe*)—he praises; such (Agni)
- आश्रृण्वते (*āśṛṇvate*)—who listens attentively to the praise
- अदृपिताय (*adṛpitāya*)—the unheedless one
- नृचक्षसे (*nṛcakṣase*)—who looks upon men
- सुमृळीकाय (*sumṛḷīkāya*)—the giver of happiness
- अमृताय (*amṛtāya*)—free from the nature of death
- देवाय (*devāya*)—and of divine nature; addressing that Agni
- मन्म (*manma*)—the praise
- शस्तिं (*śastiṃ*)—the śastra mantra
- शंस (*śaṃsa*)—recite

Gist

O praiser, recite the praise and the śastra mantra to that Agni whom the sacrificer, pressing the sweet Soma and making a sound like the stones that press it, praises: Agni who listens attentively to the praise, who is unheedless, who looks upon men, who gives happiness, who is free from the nature of death, and who is of divine nature.

English translation

Repeat, oh priest, the praise, the prayer, to the attentive, the affable Agni, the beholder of man, the giver of felicity, the divine, the immortal ; to him whom the effuser of the libation, like the (bruising) stone, adores aloud.

Special Topics

Sotā grāveva: here the sweet sound of the stone, which crushes the Soma-creepers and presses out the juice, is compared to the sound of praising Agni. On this matter, the commentator points out here that there is a whole sūkta (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-94), प्रैते वदंतु प्र वयं वदाम ग्रावभ्यः (*praite vadaṃtu pra vayaṃ vadāma grāvabhyaḥ*), for praising the stones called grāvāṇaḥ that press out the Soma juice.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वं चि॑न्न॒ः शम्या॑ अग्ने अ॒स्या ऋ॒तस्य॑ बोध्यृतचित्स्वा॒धीः ।
कु॒दा तं॑ उ॒क्था सं॑ध॒माद्या॑नि कु॒दा भं॑वन्ति स॒ख्या गृ॒हे ते॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *tvaṃ cinnaḥ śamyā agne asyā ṛtasya bodhyṛtacitsvādhīḥ |*
> *kadā ta ukthā sadhamādyāni kadā bhavanti sakhyā gṛhe te ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । चित् । नः । शम्यै । अग्ने । अस्याः । ऋतस्य । बोधि । ऋतचित् । सुआधीः ।
> कवा । ते । उक्था । सधर्माद्यानि । कदा ! भवंति । सख्या ! गृहे । ते ॥ ४ ॥

> *tvaṃ | cit | naḥ | śamyai | agne | asyāḥ | ṛtasya | bodhi | ṛtacit | suādhīḥ |*
> *kavā | te | ukthā | sadharmādyāni | kadā ! bhavaṃti | sakhyā ! gṛhe | te ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने त्वं चित्त्वमेव शम्यै । शमीशब्दः कर्मनाम । अस्याः शम्यै
> नोऽस्मत्संबंधिनोऽस्य कर्मणो देवता भवसि । हे ऋतचित् सत्यज्ञ हे अग्ने
> स्वाधीः सुकर्मा सुध्यानो वा त्वमृतस्य बोधि । अस्मदीयं स्तोत्रं बुध्यस्व ।
> ते तव सधमाद्यानि सहमदनिमित्तान्युक्ता शस्त्राणि कदा कस्मिन्काले भवंति । भविष्यंति ।
> तथास्मदीये गृहे ते त्वया सह सख्या सख्यानि कदा भविष्यंति ॥ सधमाद्यानि ।
> मादयतेर्ण्यंतस्याचो यदिति यत् । सध मादस्थयोरिति सहस्य सधादेशः । भवंति ।
> विभाषा कदाकर्ह्योर्व्यः । पा– ३–३–५ । इति भविष्यदर्थे लट् ॥

> *he agne tvaṃ cittvameva śamyai | śamīśabdaḥ karmanāma | asyāḥ śamyai*
> *no 'smatsaṃbaṃdhino 'sya karmaṇo devatā bhavasi | he ṛtacit satyajña he agne*
> *svādhīḥ sukarmā sudhyāno vā tvamṛtasya bodhi | asmadīyaṃ stotraṃ*

> *budhyasva |*
> *te tava sadhamādyāni sahamadanimittānyukkā śastrāṇi kadā*
> *kasminkāle bhavaṃti | bhaviṣyaṃti |*
> *tathāsmadīye gṛhe te tvayā saha sakhyā sakhyāni kadā bhaviṣyaṃti ‖*
> *sadhamādyāni | mādayaterṇyaṃtasyāco yaditi yat | sadha*
> *mādasthayoriti sahasya sadhādeśaḥ | bhavaṃti |*
> *vibhāṣā kadākarhorvyaḥ | pā- 3-3-5 | iti bhaviṣyadarthe laṭ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you alone are the deity of this our rite; "śamī" is a word for rite (karma), and "śamyai" means of this rite of ours. O Ṛtacit, knower of truth, O Agni, you who do good works or have good thoughts (स्वाधीः (*svādhīḥ*)), know our praise (बोधि (*bodhi*): understand our hymn). When will the śastras that serve for rejoicing together (सधमाद्यानि (*sadhamādyāni*)) with you be recited (भवंति (*bhavaṃti*), "will be")? And when will friendships with you come to be in our house?

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- त्वं चित् (*tvaṃ cit*)—you alone
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- अस्याः शम्यै (*asyāḥ śamyai*)—the deity connected with this rite
- ऋतचित् (*ṛtacit*)—Agni, knower of truth
- स्वाधीः (*svādhīḥ*)—you, the excellent doer of the rite
- ते (*te*)—for you
- सधमाद्यानि (*sadhamādyāni*)—that give delight
- उक्ता (*uktā*)—the śastra mantras
- कना (*kanā*)—when
- भवंति (*bhavaṃti*)—are made
- गृहे (*gṛhe*)—in our sacrificial house
- ते (*te*)—with you
- सख्या (*sakhyā*)—friendship
- कदा (*kadā*)—when it comes about, then
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—our praise
- बोधि (*bodhi*)—know

Gist

O Agni, you are the deity of this our rite. O Agni, knower of truth, you, the excellent doer of the rite: when the delight-giving śastras are made for you, when friendship with you comes about in our sacrificial house, then know our praise.

English translation

You, Agni, preside over this our rite : do you, who are cognizant of truth, and the author of good works, recognize this our adoration, whenever these exhilarating prayers (are addressed) to you, whenever friendly relations with you are (established) in our dwelling.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒था ह॒ तद्वरु॑णाय॒ त्वम॑ग्ने क॒था दि॒वे ग॑र्हसे॒ कन्न॒ आग॑ः ।
क॒था मि॒त्राय॑ मी॒ळ्हुषे॑ पृथि॒व्यै ब्र॒वः॑ कद॑र्य॒म्णे कद्भगा॑य ॥ ५ ॥

> *kathā ha tadvaruṇāya tvamagne kathā dive garhase kanna āgaḥ |*
> *kathā mitrāya mīḻhuṣe pṛthivyai bravaḥ kadaryamṇe kadbhagāya ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कथा । ह । तत् । वरुणाय । त्वं । अग्ने । कथा । दिवे । गर्हसे । कत् । नः । आगः ।
> कथा । मित्राय । मीळ्हुषे । पृथिव्यै । ब्रवः । कत् । अर्यम्ने । कत् । भगाय ॥

> *kathā | ha | tat | varuṇāya | tvaṃ | agne | kathā | dive | garhase | kat | naḥ | āgaḥ |*
> *kathā | mitrāya | mīḻhuṣe | pṛthivyai | bravaḥ | kat | aryamne | kat | bhagāya ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने त्वं तदस्मदीयं पापं वरुणाय कथा गर्हसे । केन हेतुना
> गर्हापूर्वमावेदयेः । हेति पूरणः । दिवे द्युलोकाय द्योतमानाय
> सूर्याय ना कथा कथं तत्पापमावेदयेः । नोऽस्माकमागस्तत्पापं कत्किमस्ति ।

> *he agne tvaṃ tadasmadīyaṃ pāpaṃ varuṇāya kathā garhase | kena hetunā*
> *garhāpūrvamāvedayeḥ | heti pūraṇaḥ | dive dyulokāya dyotamānāya*
> *sūryāya nā kathā kathaṃ tatpāpamāvedayeḥ | no 'smākamāgastatpāpaṃ katkimasti |*

> त्वत्परिचरणान्नास्तीत्यर्थः । तथा मीळ्हुषेभिमतफलसेक्रे मित्राय पृथिव्यै च कथा
> ब्रवः । कथनागो ब्रूयाः । अर्यण्णे देवाय भगाय्केतन्नामकाय च देवाय कत्कथं ब्रूयाः ॥ कथा ।
> किंशब्दात्था हेतौ च छंदसीति थाप्रत्ययः । प्राग्दिशो
> विभक्तिरिति विभक्ति संज्ञायां किमः कः । पा. ७–२–१०३ । इति कादेशः । मीळ्हुषे । मिह
> सेचने । क्वसौ दाश्वान् साह्वान् मीढ्वांश्चेति निपातितः । ब्रवः । ब्रूञ् व्यक्तायां
> वाचि । लेटि लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः । पादादित्वादनिघातः । आगमस्यानुदात्तत्वा
> द्धातुस्वरः ॥

> *tvatparicaraṇānnāstītyarthaḥ | tathā mīḻhuṣebhimataphalasekre mitrāya pṛthivyai ca kathā*
> *bravaḥ | kathanāgo brūyāḥ | aryaṇṇe devāya bhagāykètannāmakāya ca devāya katkathaṃ brūyāḥ ‖ kathā | kiṃśabdātthā hetau ca chaṃdasīti thāpratyayaḥ | prāgdiśo*
> *vibhaktiriti vibhakti saṃjñāyāṃ kimaḥ kaḥ | pā. 7-2-103 | iti kādeśaḥ | mīḻhuṣe | miha*
> *secane | kvasau dāśvān sāhvān mīḍhvāṃśceti nipātitaḥ | bravaḥ | brūñ vyaktāyāṃ*
> *vāci | leṭi leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ | pādāditvādanighātaḥ | āgamasyānudāttatvā*
> *ddhātusvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, why do you reproach that sin of ours to Varuṇa? For what reason would you make it known after reproaching? "Ha" is a filler. To Heaven (the heavenly world, or the shining Sūrya) why would you make known that sin? What (कत् (*kat*)) sin of ours is there? The meaning is that there is none, because of our service to you.

Likewise, why would you speak to Mitra, the showerer of desired fruit, and to Earth? Why would you speak of the offence? To the god Aryaman, and to the god named Bhaga, why would you speak?

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- तत् (*tat*)—our sin
- वरुणाय (*varuṇāya*)—to Varuṇa
- कथा (*kathā*)—why
- गर्हसे (*garhase*)—do you make it known and reproach us
- दिवे (*dive*)—to the heavenly world
- कथा (*kathā*)—why would you make it known
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- आगः (*āgaḥ*)—sin
- कत् (*kat*)—what could it be
- मीळ्हुषे (*mīḷhuṣe*)—the granter of desired ends
- मित्राय (*mitrāya*)—to Mitra
- पृथिव्यै च (*pṛthivyai ca*)—and to Earth
- कथा (*kathā*)—why
- ब्रवः (*bravaḥ*)—do you say
- अरम्ये (*aramye*)—to Aryaman
- भगाय (*bhagāya*)—to Bhaga
- कत् (*kat*)—why would you make it known

Gist

O Agni, why do you make our sin known to Varuṇa and reproach us? What sin of ours could there be? Why would you make it known to Heaven, to Mitra the granter of desired ends, to Earth, to Aryaman and to Bhaga?

English translation

Why, Agni, do you reproach us (for our sin) to Varuna, why to the heaven ? what is our offence ? why repeat it to the bountiful Mitra, to earth, to Aryaman, or to Bhaga ?

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कद्धिष्ण्या॑सु वृधसा॒नो अ॑ग्ने॒ कद्वाता॑य॒ प्रत॑वसे शुभं॒ये ।
परि॑ज्मने॒ नास॑त्याय॒ क्षे ब्रव॒◌ः कद॑ग्ने रु॒द्राय॑ नृ॒घ्ने ॥ ६ ॥

> *kaddhiṣṇyāsu vṛdhasāno agne kadvātāya pratavase śubhaṃye |*
> *parijmane nāsatyāya kṣe bravaḥ kadagne rudrāya nṛghne ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कत् । धिष्ण्यासु । वृधसानः । अग्ने । कत् । वाताय । प्रतवसे । शुभंऽये ।

> *kat | dhiṣṇyāsu | vṛdhasānaḥ | agne | kat | vātāya | pratavase | śubhaṃ 'ye |*

> परिज्मने । नासत्याय । क्षे । ब्रवः । कत् । अग्ने । रुद्राय । नृघ्ने ॥ ६ ॥

> *parijmane | nāsatyāya | kṣe | bravaḥ | kat | agne | rudrāya | nṛghne ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने धिष्णा स्वाग्नीध्रीयादिधिष्टेषु वृधसानो घृताद्याहुतिभिर्वर्धमानस्त्वं कत्कथं ब्रूयाः ।
> प्रतवसे प्रकृष्टबलाय शुभंये शुभस्य प्रापयित्रे
> परिज्मने परितो गंत्रे नासत्याय सत्यस्य नेत्रे । यद्वा । न विद्यतेऽसत्यं यस्य
> तस्मै वाताय वायवे । यद्वा । नासत्यायेति वचनव्यत्ययः । नासत्याभ्यामश्विभ्यां । क्षे । क्षेति
> पृथिवीमाह । क्षियंति निवसंत्यस्यां प्राणिन इति । तस्यै क्षे पृथिव्यै
> च कत्कथं ब्रूयाः । हे अग्ने नृष्टे नृणां पापकृतां हंत्री रुद्राय देवाय
> कत्कथमागो ब्रुवः । ब्रूयाः ॥ वृधसानः । वृधु वर्धने ।
> असानजित्यनुवृत्तावृंजिवृधिमंदिसहिभ्यः किदित्यसानच्प्रत्ययः । कित्वादगुणः ।
> चित्वादंतोदात्तः शुभंये । या प्रापणे । विच् । तत्पुरुषे कृति बहुलमिति द्वितीयाया अप्यलुक् ।
> कृत्स्वरः । क्षे । क्षि निवासगत्योः । अन्वेभ्योऽपि दृश्यत इत्यधिकरणे डः । ततष्टाप् ।
> चतुर्थेकवचन आतो धातोरित्यत्रात इति योगविभागादाकारलोपः । नृष्टे । हन
> हिंसागत्योः । बहुलं छंदसीति क्वप् ॥

> *he agne dhiṣṇā svāgnīdhrīyādidhiṣṭeṣu vṛdhasāno*
> *ghṛtādyāhutibhirvardhamānastvaṃ katkathaṃ brūyāḥ | pratavase*
> *prakṛṣṭabalāya śubhaṃye śubhasya prāpayitre*
> *parijmane parito gaṃtre nāsatyāya satyasya netre | yadvā | na vidyate 'satyaṃ yasya*
> *tasmai vātāya vāyave | yadvā | nāsatyāyeti vacanavyatyayaḥ |*
> *nāsatyābhyāmaśvibhyāṃ | kṣe | kṣeti pṛthivīmāha | kṣiyaṃti*
> *nivasaṃtyasyāṃ prāṇina iti | tasyai kṣe pṛthivyai*
> *ca katkathaṃ brūyāḥ | he agne nṛṣṭe nṛṇāṃ pāpakṛtāṃ haṃtrī rudrāya devāya*
> *katkathamāgo bruvaḥ | brūyāḥ ‖ vṛdhasānaḥ | vṛdhu vardhane |*
> *asānajityanuvṛttāvṛṃjivṛdhimaṃdisahibhyaḥ kidityasānacpratyayaḥ |*
> *kitvādaguṇaḥ | citvādaṃtodāttaḥ śubhaṃye | yā prāpaṇe | vic |*
> *tatpuruṣe kṛti bahulamiti dvitīyāyā apyaluk |*
> *kṛtsvaraḥ | kṣe | kṣi nivāsagatyoḥ | anvebhyo 'pi dṛśyata ityadhikaraṇe ḍaḥ | tataṣṭāp |*
> *caturthekavacana āto dhātorityatrāta iti yogavibhāgādākāralopaḥ | nṛṣṭe | hana*
> *hiṃsāgatyoḥ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti kvap ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you who grow in the dhiṣṇyas, the hearths such as the Āgnīdhrīya, with oblations of ghee and the like, why (कत् (*kat*)) would you speak? To Pratavas, of exceeding strength; to Śubhaṃyu, the bringer of good; to Parijman, who goes about everywhere; to Nāsatya, the leader of truth. Or else: the one in whom there is no untruth, namely Vāta, the Wind. Or else "nāsatyāya" is a change of number, meaning the two Nāsatyas, the Aśvins. "Kṣe": क्षेति पृथिवीमाह (*kṣeti pṛthivīmāha*); beings dwell (क्षियंति (*kṣiyaṃti*)) in it. To that Kṣā, Earth, why would you speak? O Agni, to the god Rudra, the destroyer of men who commit sin (नृष्टे (*nṛṣṭe*)), why would you tell of the offence?[?371]

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- धिष्ण्यासु (*dhiṣṇyāsu*)—in the sacrificial places
- वृधसानः (*vṛdhasānaḥ*)—you who grow
- प्रतवसे (*pratavase*)—who has excellent strength
- शुभंये (*śubhaṃye*)—the bringer of good
- परिज्मने (*parijmane*)—who moves everywhere
- नासत्याय (*nāsatyāya*)—who is of the nature of truth
- वातायु (*vātāyu*)—to the Wind
- कत् (*kat*)—how would you make my sin known?
- क्षे (*kṣe*)—to Earth
- कत् (*kat*)—why (how) do you tell it
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- नृष्टे (*nṛṣṭe*)—who destroys sinful men
- रुद्राय (*rudrāya*)—to the god Rudra
- कत् (*kat*)—why
- ब्रव (*brava*)—do you tell

Gist

O Agni, you who grow in the sacrificial places, why do you make my sin known to the Wind, who has excellent strength, brings good, moves everywhere and is of the nature of truth, to Earth, and to the god Rudra who destroys sinful men?

English translation

Why repeat it when exalted in holy ceremonies ? why tell it to the mightv, benevolent, circumambient, truthful wind (Vayu) ? why, Agni, to earth, why to man-destroying Rudra ?

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒था म॒हे पु॑ष्टिम्भ॒राय॑ पू॒ष्णे कद्रु॒द्राय॒ सुम॑खाय हवि॒र्दे ।
कद्विष्ण॑व उरुगा॒याय॒ रेतो॒ ब्रव॒ः कद॑ग्ने॒ शर॑वे बृह॒त्यै ॥ ७ ॥

> *kathā mahe puṣṭimbharāya pūṣṇe kadrudrāya sumakhāya havirde |*
> *kadviṣṇava urugāyāya reto bravaḥ kadagne śarave bṛhatyai ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कथा । महे । पुष्टिंभराय । पूष्णे । कत् । रुद्राय । सुमखाय । हविःदे ।
> कत् । विष्णवे । उरुग्गायाय । रेतः । ब्रवः । कत् । अग्ने । शरवे । बृहत्यै ॥ ७ ॥

> *kathā | mahe | puṣṭiṃbharāya | pūṣṇe | kat | rudrāya | sumakhāya | haviḥde |*
> *kat | viṣṇave | uruggāyāya | retaḥ | bravaḥ | kat | agne | śarave | bṛhatyai ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने महे महते पुष्टिंभराय पुष्टिधारकाय पूष्ण एतन्नामकाय
> देवाय कथा केन हेतुना पापं ब्रवीथाः । सुमखाय सुपूजनीयाय सुयज्ञाय वा हविर्देऽग्निरूपेण
> देवानां हविर्दात्रे । यद्वा । स्विष्टकृत्वाद्ध विषो
> दात्रे । रुद्राय कत्कथं ब्रूयाः । तथोरुगायायोरुभिर्बहुभिर्गायमानाय
> यद्वा । प्रभूतकीर्तये विष्णवे रेतः क्षयहेतु पापं कत्कथं वदेः । शरवे ।
> शृणाति पक्वा ओषधीरिति शरुः शरत्संवत्सरः । यद्वा । हिंसिका निर्ऋतिः । बृहत्यै
> महत्यै शरदे निर्ऋत्यै ना कत्कथं पापं ब्रवः । ब्रूयाः ॥ पुष्टिंभराय डुभृञ्
> धारणपोषणयोः । संज्ञायां भृत्यवृजीत्यादिना खच् । अरुर्द्विषदजंतस्य
> मुमिति पूर्वपदस्य मुमागमः। चित्तादंतोदात्तः । समासे कृत्स्वरः । हविर्दे ॥
> अनुदात्तस्य च यत्रोदात्तलोप इति सुप उदात्तत्वं । शरवे । शृ हिंसायां ।
> शास्वस्निहित्यसीत्यादिना उप्रत्ययः । निदित्यनुवृत्तेराद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he agne mahe mahate puṣṭiṃbharāya puṣṭidhārakāya pūṣṇa etannāmakāya*
> *devāya kathā kena hetunā pāpaṃ bravīthāḥ | sumakhāya supūjanīyāya suyajñāya vā havirde 'gnirūpeṇa devānāṃ havirdātre | yadvā | sviṣṭakṛtvāddha viṣo*
> *dātre | rudrāya katkathaṃ brūyāḥ | tathorugāyāyorubhirbahubhirgāyamānāya*
> *yadvā | prabhūtakīrtaye viṣṇave retaḥ kṣayahetu pāpaṃ katkathaṃ vadeḥ | śarave |*
> *śṛṇāti pakvā oṣadhīriti śaruḥ śaratsaṃvatsaraḥ | yadvā | hiṃsikā nirṛtiḥ | bṛhatyai*
> *mahatyai śarade nirṛtyai nā katkathaṃ pāpaṃ bravaḥ | brūyāḥ ‖ puṣṭiṃbharāya ḍubhṛñ*
> *dhāraṇapoṣaṇayoḥ | saṃjñāyāṃ bhṛtyavṛjītyādinā khac | arurdviṣadajaṃtasya*
> *mumiti pūrvapadasya mumāgamaḥ| cittādaṃtodāttaḥ | samāse kṛtsvaraḥ | havirde ‖*
> *anudāttasya ca yatrodāttalopa iti supa udāttatvaṃ | śarave | śṛ hiṃsāyāṃ |*
> *śāsvasnihityasītyādinā upratyayaḥ | nidityanuvṛtterādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, to great Pūṣan, the bearer of nourishment (पुष्टिंभराय (*puṣṭiṃbharāya*)), a god of that name, for what reason would you speak of the sin? To Rudra, well worthy of worship or of good sacrifice (सुमखाय (*sumakhāya*)), the giver of oblations (हविर्दे (*havirde*)) to the gods in the form of Agni; or else, as Sviṣṭakṛt, the giver of the oblation: why would you speak? Likewise to Viṣṇu, उरुगायाय (*urugāyāya*), sung by many, or of abundant fame: why would you speak of the sin that causes loss of semen (रेतः (*retaḥ*))? "Śaru": that which crushes the ripened herbs, the autumn, the year; or else the violent Nirṛti. To great Śarad or Nirṛti, why would you tell the sin?

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- महे (*mahe*)—of great nature
- पुष्टिंभराय (*puṣṭiṃbharāya*)—the nourisher of the world
- पूष्टे (*pūṣṭe*)—to the god Pūṣan
- कथा (*kathā*)—for what reason (would you make known my sin)
- सुमखाय (*sumakhāya*)—who is worthy of excellent worship
- हविर्दे (*havirde*)—who offers the oblation in the form of Agni
- रुद्राय (*rudrāya*)—to Rudra
- कत् (*kat*)—why do you speak
- शरवे (*śarave*)—to the presiding deity of the year
- बृहत्यै (*bṛhatyai*)—and to Nirṛti
- कत् (*kat*)—how
- ब्रवः (*bravaḥ*)—do you speak
- उरुगायाय (*urugāyāya*)—in many ways

Why should my sin, the cause of decay, be told to Pūṣan, who is of great nature and nourishes the world? Why to Rudra, who is worthy of excellent worship and offers the oblation to the gods in the form of fire? Why to the presiding deity of the year, to Nirṛti, and to Viṣṇu, who is praised in many ways?

Gist

O Agni, why must my sin, the cause of decay, be told to Pūṣan, who is of great nature and the nourisher of the world; to Rudra, who is worthy of excellent worship and offers the oblation to the gods in the form of fire; to the presiding deity of the year; to Nirṛti; and to Viṣṇu, who is much praised?

English translation

Why to the great and nutriment-conveying Pushan ? why to Rudra, the object of worship, the giver of the oblation (to the gods) ? Why to the many-hymned Vishnu ? Why tell our sin to the extensive year ?

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒था शर्धा॑य म॒रुता॑मृ॒ताय॑ क॒था सू॒रे बृ॑ह॒ते पृ॒च्छ्यमा॑नः ।
प्रति॑ ब्र॒वोऽदि॑तये तु॒राय॒ साधा॑ दि॒वो जा॑तवेदश्चिकि॒त्वान् ॥ ८ ॥

> *kathā śardhāya marutāmṛtāya kathā sūre bṛhate pṛcchyamānaḥ |*
> *prati bravo 'ditaye turāya sādhā divo jātavedaścikitvān ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कथा । शर्धाय । मरुतां । ऋताय । कथा । सूरे । बृहते । पृच्छ्यमानः ।
> प्रति । ब्रवः । अदितये । तुराय । साध । दिवः । जातवेदः । चिकित्वान् ॥ ८ ॥

> *kathā | śardhāya | marutāṃ | ṛtāya | kathā | sūre | bṛhate | pṛcchyamānaḥ |*
> *prati | bravaḥ | aditaye | turāya | sādha | divaḥ | jātavedaḥ | cikitvān ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ऋताय गंत्रे सत्यभूताय ना मरुतां शर्धाय बलभूताय
> गणाय कथा केन हेतुना मदीयमागः प्रतिब्रूयाः । तेन पृच्छमानः सन्
> तस्मै बृहते महते सूरे सूराय कथा कथं वदेः । तथादितये देव्य तुराय
> त्वरितगमनाय वायवे । अदितयेऽदीनाय तुराय ना । प्रति ब्रवः । मदीय–

> *he agne ṛtāya gaṃtre satyabhūtāya nā marutāṃ śardhāya balabhūtāya*
> *gaṇāya kathā kena hetunā madīyamāgaḥ pratibrūyāḥ | tena pṛcchamānaḥ san*
> *tasmai bṛhate mahate sūre sūrāya kathā kathaṃ vadeḥ | tathāditaye devya turāya*
> *tvaritagamanāya vāyave | aditaye 'dīnāya turāya nā | prati bravaḥ | madīya-*

> मागः कथं प्रतिब्रूयाः । यस्मादेवं तस्मात् हे जातवेदोग्ने चिकित्वान्
> तत्सर्वं जानानस्त्वं दिवो दीप्तान्देवान् साध । साधय । गच्छ । यद्वा । दिवो
> द्युलोकस्य यज्ञवहनलक्षणं कार्यं साध । कुरु ॥ सूरे । सर्वविधीनां छंदसि
> विकल्पितत्वात् जतीर्यत्वाभावः । अतो गुण इति पररूपत्वं । पृच्छमानः । पृच्छ
> ज्ञिप्पायां । कर्मणि यक् । ग्रहिज्यादिना संप्रसारणं । शानचो लसार्वधातुकानुदात्तत्वे
> यक्स्वरः । साध । राध साध संसिद्धौ । अंतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य लोटि व्यत्ययेन शप् ॥

> *māgaḥ kathaṃ pratibrūyāḥ | yasmādevaṃ tasmāt he jātavedogne cikitvān*
> *tatsarvaṃ jānānastvaṃ divo dīptāndevān sādha | sādhaya | gaccha | yadvā | divo*
> *dyulokasya yajñavahanalakṣaṇaṃ kāryaṃ sādha | kuru ‖ sūre | sarvavidhīnāṃ chaṃdasi*
> *vikalpitatvāt jatīryatvābhāvaḥ | ato guṇa iti pararūpatvaṃ | pṛcchamānaḥ | pṛccha*
> *jñippāyāṃ | karmaṇi yak | grahijyādinā saṃprasāraṇaṃ | śānaco*
> *lasārvadhātukānudāttatve yaksvaraḥ | sādha | rādha sādha saṃsiddhau*
> *| aṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya loṭi vyatyayena śap ‖*

Summary

O Agni, to the true, moving company of the Maruts, who are strength itself, by what cause would you declare my sin in reply? Being asked by them, how would you speak to that great Sūra? Likewise to Aditi,

and to the swift-going Vāyu; "aditaye" is also taken as "to the unimpoverished, swift one". How would you reply with my sin? Since it is so, O Jātavedas ... (continued on the next page).

Since it is so, O Jātavedas Agni, knowing all that, you, the knowing one, bring about (go to) the shining gods; or else accomplish the task of heaven, the carrying of the sacrifice. Grammatical remarks follow on "sūre", "pṛcchamānaḥ" and "sādha"; they are omitted here.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋताय (*ṛtāya*)—true in nature
- मरुतां (*marutāṃ*)—of the Maruts
- शर्धाय (*śardhāya*)—to the company
- कथा (*kathā*)—for what reason (shall you tell my sin)
- पृच्छ्यमानः (*pṛcchyamānaḥ*)—even if you are asked
- बृहते (*bṛhate*)—of great nature
- सूरे (*sūre*)—to Sūra
- कथा (*kathā*)—how will you tell
- अदितये (*aditaye*)—to the goddess Aditi
- तुराय (*turāya*)—to the swift-going Vāyu
- प्रति ब्रवः (*prati bravaḥ*)—how do you speak
- जातवेदः (*jātavedaḥ*)—O Agni, of born wisdom
- चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*)—you, having known all
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—to the shining gods
- साध (*sādha*)—go and join

Gist

O Agni, for what reason will you tell my sin to the company of the true Maruts? Even if you are asked, how will you tell it to the sun of great nature? How will you tell it to the goddess Aditi and to the swift-going Vāyu? O Agni of born wisdom, knowing everything, go and join the shining gods.

English translation

Why tell it to the veracious company of the Maruts? why, even when asked, to the mighty sun? Why repeat it to Aditi, or to the swift wind? Fulfil, all-knowing Jatavedas, (the worship) of heaven.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तेन॑ ऋ॒तं निय॑तमीळ॒ आ गोरा॒मा सचा॒ मधु॑मत्प॒क्वम॑ग्ने ।
कृ॒ष्णा स॒ती रुश॑ता धा॒सिनै॒षा जाम॑र्येण॒ पय॑सा पीपाय ॥ ९ ॥

> *ṛtena ṛtaṃ niyatamīḷa ā gorāmā sacā madhumatpakvamagne |*
> *kṛṣṇā satī ruśatā dhāsinaiṣā jāmaryeṇa payasā pīpāya ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतेन । ऋतं । नियुतं । ईळे । आ । गोः । आमा । सचा । मधुमत् । पक्वं ।
> अग्ने ।
> कृष्णा । सतिः । रुशता । धासिना । एषा । जामर्येण । पयसा । पीपाय ॥ ९ ॥

> *ṛtena | ṛtaṃ | niyutaṃ | īḷe | ā | goḥ | āmā | sacā | madhumat |*
> *pakvaṃ |*
> *agne |*
> *kṛṣṇā | satiḥ | ruśatā | dhāsinā | eṣā | jāmaryeṇa | payasā | pīpāya ‖ 9*
> *‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ऋतेन सत्यभूतेन यज्ञेन नियतमनुस्युतमृतमुदकं गोर्धेनोः पय एळे । आयाचे ।
> सांनाय्यादिहविरर्थं गव्यं पयस्त्वां याच
> इत्यभिप्रायः । आमापक्वा सा गौर्मधुमन्माधुर्योपेतं पक्वं पयः सचा सह
> धारयति । कृष्णा कृष्णवर्णा सत्येषा गौ रुशता श्वेतेन धासिना प्राणिनां धारकेण

> जामर्येण । जायंत इति जाः प्रजाः । ता जा अमर्येणामरणनिमित्तेन तेन
> पयसा पीषाय । प्रजाः स्न्याययति । तवैष महिमा यद्रसान्परिणामयन्नेवं
> करोषि ॥ पीषाय । स्न्यायतेर्लिटि लिड्यजटोश्चति पीभावः ॥

> *he agne ṛtena satyabhūtena yajñena niyatamanusyutamṛtamudakaṃ gordhenoḥ paya eḷe | āyāce | sāṃnāyyādihavirarthaṃ gavyaṃ payastvāṃ yāca*
> *ityabhiprāyaḥ | āmāpakvā sā gaurmadhumanmādhuryopetaṃ pakvaṃ payaḥ sacā saha*
> *dhārayati | kṛṣṇā kṛṣṇavarṇā satyeṣā gau ruśatā śvetena dhāsinā prāṇināṃ dhārakeṇa*
> *jāmaryeṇa | jāyaṃta iti jāḥ prajāḥ | tā jā amaryeṇāmaraṇanimittena tena*
> *payasā pīṣāya | prajāḥ snyāyayati | tavaiṣa mahimā yadrasānpariṇāmayannevaṃ*
> *karoṣi ‖ pīṣāya | snyāyaterliṭi liḍyajaṭoścati pībhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, by the sacrifice that is truth, I ask for the water that is bound up with it, and for the milk of the cow; the intention is "for the oblations such as sāṃnāyya I ask you for cow's milk". That cow, though unripe, holds sweet, ripe milk with her. Though black, this cow, with white milk that sustains living beings, "jāmarya": "jāḥ" are the offspring, those born; with that milk, the cause of their deathlessness, she makes the offspring swell. "This is your greatness, that you do so, transforming the juices."

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ऋतेन (*ṛtena*)—by the sacrifice that is truth
- नियतं (*niyataṃ*)—bound up with
- ऋतं (*ṛtaṃ*)—water
- गोः (*goḥ*)—the milk of the cow
- आ ईळे (*ā īḷe*)—I ask for
- आमा (*āmā*)—(the cow) even in the unripe state
- मधुमत् (*madhumat*)—sweet
- पक्वं (*pakvaṃ*)—ripe, of milk

- सचा (*sacā*)—holds within herself
- कृष्णा सती (*kṛṣṇā satī*)—being black
- एषा (*eṣā*)—this cow
- रुशता (*ruśatā*)—white
- धासिना (*dhāsinā*)—sustaining living beings
- जामरैण (*jāmaraiṇa*)—causing deathlessness to the offspring
- पयसा (*payasā*)—with milk
- पीपाय (*pīpāya*)—satisfies the offspring

Gist

O Agni, by the sacrifice that is truth I ask for the water bound up with it and for the milk of the cow. Even though not in the ripe state, this cow holds within herself sweet, ripe milk. This black cow satisfies the offspring with white milk that sustains living beings and causes deathlessness.

English translation

I solicit, Agni, the milk of the cow, essential for the sacrifice yet immature, (she possesses) the sweet and ripe (fluid); black though she be, yet with her white nutritious milk she maintains mankind in existence.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तेन॒ हि ष्मा॑ वृष॒भश्चि॑द॒क्तः पुमाँ॑ अ॒ग्निः पय॑सा पृ॒ष्ठ्ये॑न ।
अस्प॑न्दमानो अचरद्वयो॒धा वृषा॑ शु॒क्रं दु॑दु॒हे पृश्नि॒रूध॑ः ॥ १० ॥

> *ṛtena hi ṣmā vṛṣabhaścidaktaḥ pumā~ agniḥ payasā pṛṣṭhyena |*
> *aspandamāno acaradvayodhā vṛṣā śukraṃ duduhe pṛśnirūdhaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतेन । हि । स्मृ । वृषभः । चित् । अक्तः । पुमान् । अग्निः । पयसा । पृष्ट्येन ।
> अस्पंदमानः । अचरत् । वयधाः । वृषा । शुक्रं । दुदुहे । पृश्निः । ऊधः ॥१०॥

> *ṛtena | hi | smṛ | vṛṣabhaḥ | cit | aktaḥ | pumān | agniḥ | payasā | pṛṣṭyena |*
> *aspaṃdamānaḥ | acarat | vayadhāḥ | vṛṣā | śukraṃ | duduhe | pṛśniḥ | ūdhaḥ ‖10‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वृषभोऽभिमतफलवर्षकः पुमान् श्रेष्ठः सोऽग्निरृतेन सत्यभूतेन
> पृष्येन धारकेण पयसाक्तः सिक्तो भवति । हि ष्मचित् त्रयः पूरणाः । वयोधा
> अन्नदः सोऽग्निरस्पंदमान एकत्रावस्थितः सन् एवाचरत् । सर्वत्र तेजसा चरति ।
> तथा वृषापां वर्षकः पृश्निः सूर्यः शुक्रं पय ऊधोऽंतरिक्षं मेघं वा
> दुदुहे । दोग्धि ॥ अक्तः । अन्नू व्यक्तिम्रक्षणगतिषु । कर्मणि निष्ठा । दुदुहे ।
> द्विकर्मकोयं धातुः । ऊधः । अकथितं चेति कर्मसंज्ञा ॥

> *vṛṣabho 'bhimataphalavarṣakaḥ pumān śreṣṭhaḥ so 'gniṛtena satyabhūtena*
> *pṛṣyena dhārakeṇa payasāktaḥ sikto bhavati | hi ṣmacit trayaḥ pūraṇāḥ | vayodhā*
> *annadaḥ so 'gniraspaṃdamāna ekatrāvasthitaḥ san evācarat | sarvatra tejasā carati |*
> *tathā vṛṣāpāṃ varṣakaḥ pṛśniḥ sūryaḥ śukraṃ paya ūdho 'ṃtarikṣaṃ meghaṃ vā*
> *duduhe | dogdhi ‖ aktaḥ | annū vyaktimrakṣaṇagatiṣu | karmaṇi niṣṭhā | duduhe |*
> *dvikarmakoyaṃ dhātuḥ | ūdhaḥ | akathitaṃ ceti karmasaṃjñā ‖*

Summary

The "vṛṣabha", the showerer of desired fruit, the male, the best, that Agni is sprinkled with the true, sustaining milk; "hi ṣma cit" are three fillers. The giver of food (vayodhāḥ), that Agni, though standing still in one place, moves everywhere with his radiance. Likewise the showerer of waters, Pṛśni, the sun, milks the white milk, the udder, the atmosphere or cloud.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—the giver of desired things
- पुमान् (*pumān*)—the best
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- ऋतेन (*ṛtena*)—true
- पृष्ठेन (*pṛṣṭhena*)—nourishing
- पयसा (*payasā*)—with milk
- अक्तः (*aktaḥ*)—is sprinkled
- वयोधाः (*vayodhāḥ*)—Agni, the giver of food
- अस्पंदमानः (*aspaṃdamānaḥ*)—though motionless and steady
- अचरत् (*acarat*)—pervades everywhere with his radiance
- वृषा (*vṛṣā*)—the shedder of water
- पृश्निः (*pṛśniḥ*)—the sun
- शुक्रं(*śukraṃ*)—watery
- ऊधः (*ūdhaḥ*)—the atmosphere (cloud)
- दुदुहे (*duduhe*)—milks

Gist

Agni, the giver of desired things and the best, is sprinkled with true, nourishing milk. Agni, the giver of food, though motionless and steady, pervades everywhere with his radiance. The sun, who pours down water, milks the atmosphere filled with water.

English translation

The male Agni, the showerer (of benefits) has been sprinkled by the genuine sustaining milk : the giver of food proceeds unswerving (from his course), and the sun, the shedder of rain, has milked the white (fluid) of the udder (of the firmament).

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तेना॒द्रिं व्य॑सन्भि॒दन्त॒ः समङ्गि॑रसो नवन्त॒ गोभि॑ः ।
शु॒नं न॒रः परि॑ षदन्नु॒षास॑मा॒विः स्व॑रभवज्ञा॒ते अ॒ग्नौ ॥ ११ ॥

> *ṛtenādriṃ vyasanbhidantaḥ samaṅgiraso navanta gobhiḥ |*
> *śunaṃ naraḥ pari ṣadannuṣāsamāviḥ svarabhavajjāte agnau ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतेन । अद्रिं । वि । असन् । भिदंतः । सम् । अंगिरसः । नवंत । गोभिः ।
> शुनं । नरः । परि । सदन् । उषसं । आविः । स्वः । अभवत् । जाते । अग्नौ ॥ ११ ॥

> *ṛtena | adriṃ | vi | asan | bhidaṃtaḥ | sam | aṃgirasaḥ | navaṃta | gobhiḥ |*
> *śunaṃ | naraḥ | pari | sadan | uṣasaṃ | āviḥ | svaḥ | abhavat | jāte | agnau ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अंगिरसो मेधातिथिप्रभृतय ऋतेन यज्ञेन हेतुना गवां निरोधकमद्रिं
> पर्वतं भिदंतो विदारयंतः संतो व्यसन् । व्यक्षिपन् । ततस्ते गोभिः सं नवंत ।
> समगच्छंत । नरः कर्मणां नेतारस्ते शुनं सुखेनोषसं परि सदन् । परितः
> प्राप्नु वन् । ततः स्वः सूर्योऽप्याविरभवत् । सर्वमेतदग्नौ त्वयि जाते मंथनेन
> निष्पादिते सत्यभूदिति ॥ असन् । अस्यतेर्लुजु च्लेरस्यतिवक्तीत्यादिनाजादेशः ।
> अनित्यमागमशासनमिति थुगभावः ॥

> *aṃgiraso medhātithiprabhṛtaya ṛtena yajñena hetunā gavāṃ nirodhakamadriṃ*
> *parvataṃ bhidaṃto vidārayaṃtaḥ saṃto vyasan | vyakṣipan | tataste gobhiḥ saṃ navaṃta |*
> *samagacchaṃta | naraḥ karmaṇāṃ netāraste śunaṃ sukhenoṣasaṃ pari sadan | paritaḥ*

> *prāpnu van | tataḥ svaḥ sūryo 'pyāvirabhavat | sarvametadagnau tvayi jāte maṃthanena*
> *niṣpādite satyabhūditi || asan | asyaterluju clerasyativaktītyādinājādeśaḥ | anityamāgamaśāsanamiti thugabhāvaḥ ||*

Summary

The Aṅgirases, Medhātithi and others, by the sacrifice as cause, splitting the mountain that obstructed the cows, threw it open ("vyasan": they cast apart). Then they came together with the cows. The leaders of rites, they happily surrounded (reached on all sides) the dawn. Then Svaḥ, the sun, also became manifest. All this came about when you, Agni, were born, produced by churning.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्नौ (*agnau*)—you, in the form of Agni
- जाते (*jāte*)—as soon as you were born
- अंगिरसः (*aṃgirasaḥ*)—the Aṅgirases
- ऋतेन (*ṛtena*)—with the help of the sacrifice
- अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)—the mountain that had hidden the cows
- भिदंत (*bhidaṃta*)—splitting
- व्यसन् (*vyasan*)—released and made a way
- गोभिः (*gobhiḥ*)—with the cows
- सं नवंत (*saṃ navaṃta*)—returned
- नरः (*naraḥ*)—they, the performers of rites
- शुनं (*śunaṃ*)—happily
- उषसं (*uṣasaṃ*)—the dawn
- परि सदन् (*pari sadan*)—obtained all around
- स्वः (*svaḥ*)—the sun also
- आविः अभवत् (*āviḥ abhavat*)—became manifest

Gist

O Agni, as soon as you, in the form of Agni, were born, the Aṅgirases, with the help of the sacrifice, split the mountains that had hidden the cows, released them and made a way. And they returned with their cows. The performers of rites obtained the dawn all around. The sun also became manifest. All this is your greatness, as Agni[?372]

English translation

By the sacrifice, the Angirasas, rending the mountain asunder, have thrown it open, and returned with the cows ; the leaders (of holy rites) have arrived happily at the dawn, and the sun was manifest as Agni was engendered.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तेन॑ दे॒वीर॒मृता॒ अमृ॑क्ता॒ अर्णो॑भि॒रापो॒ मधु॑मद्भिरग्ने ।
वा॒जी न सर्गे॑षु प्रस्तुभा॒नः प्र स॒दमित्स्रवि॑तवे दधन्युः ॥ १२ ॥

> *ṛtena devīramṛtā amṛktā arṇobhirāpo madhumadbhiragne |*
> *vājī na sargeṣu prastubhānaḥ pra sadamitsravitave dadhanyuḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतेन । देवीः । अमृताः । अमृक्ताः । अर्णःऽभिः । आपः । मधुमत्ऽभिः । अग्ने ॥
> वाजी । न । सर्गेषु । प्रस्तुभानः । प्र । सदं । इत् । स्रवितवे । दधन्युः ॥ १२ ॥

> *ṛtena | devīḥ | amṛtāḥ | amṛktāḥ | arṇaḥ 'bhiḥ | āpaḥ | madhumat 'bhiḥ | agne ‖*
> *vājī | na | sargeṣu | prastubhānaḥ | pra | sadaṃ | it | sravitave | dadhanyuḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने अमृता अमरणहेतव अमृक्ता रक्षःप्रभृतिभिरबाधिता मधुमद्भिर्माधुर्योपेतैरर्णोभिरुदकैर्युक्ता देवीर्देव्यो नद्य ऋतेन सत्येन यज्ञेन वा हेतुनाप आप्तव्याः सत्यः सदमित्सदैव स्रवितवे स्रवणाय प्र दधन्युः । प्रगच्छंति । तत्र दृष्टांतः । वाजी न । यथा सर्गेषु प्रेरणेषु प्रस्तुभानः प्रोत्साह्यमानोऽश्वः प्रगच्छति तद्वत् ॥ अपः । अप्ल व्याप्तौ । आप्नोतेः क्विप् ह्रस्वश्चेति कर्मणि क्विप् । अप्तन्नित्यादिना जसि दीर्घः । प्रस्तुभानः । स्तोभतिरर्चतिकर्मा ॥

> *he agne amṛtā amaraṇahetava amṛktā rakṣaḥprabhṛtibhirabādhitā madhumadbhirmādhuryopetairarṇobhirudakairyuktā devīrdevyo nadya ṛtena satyena*
> *yajñena vā hetunāpa āptavyāḥ satyaḥ sadamitsadaiva sravitave sravaṇāya pra dadhanyuḥ |*
> *pragacchaṃti | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | vājī na | yathā sargeṣu preraṇeṣu prastubhānaḥ protsāhyamāno 'śvaḥ pragacchati tadvat ‖ apaḥ | apla vyāptau | āpnoteḥ kvip hrasvaśceti*
> *karmaṇi kvip | aptannityādinā jasi dīrghaḥ | prastubhānaḥ | stobhatirarcatikarmā ‖*

Summary

O Agni, the divine rivers (देवीः (*devīḥ*)) are immortal, that is, causes of non-dying, and unobstructed, that is, not hindered by Rākṣasas and the like. They are joined with sweet waters, waters endowed with sweetness. By ऋतेन (*ṛtena*), "by truth" or "by the sacrifice", as the cause, they are to be reached, and so they always flow on. स्रवितवे (*sravitave*) means "for flowing"; प्र दधन्युः (*pra dadhanyuḥ*) means "they go forth". The illustration is वाजी न (*vājī na*): as a horse, urged on in its courses (सर्गेषु (*sargeṣu*)), is encouraged and goes forth, so do the rivers. Sāyaṇa then gives grammar on अपः (*apaḥ*) (root अप्ल (*apla*), "to pervade") and on प्रस्तुभानः (*prastubhānaḥ*) (स्तोभति (*stobhati*) is a root meaning "to praise").

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अमृताः (*amṛtāḥ*)—the deathless ones
- अमृक्ताः (*amṛktāḥ*)—the unharmed ones
- मधुमद्भिः (*madhumadbhiḥ*)—endowed with sweetness
- ऊर्णोभिः (*ūrṇobhiḥ*)—full of waters
- देवीः (*devīḥ*)—the rivers, divine in nature
- ऋतेन (*ṛtena*)—with the help of the sacrifice
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—having obtained power
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—always
- स्रवितवे (*sravitave*)—to flow
- सर्गेषु (*sargeṣu*)—when urged on

- प्रस्तुभानः (*prastubhānaḥ*)—having received encouragement
- वाजी न (*vājī na*)—as a horse moves swiftly
- प्र दधन्युः (*pra dadhanyuḥ*)—they move on

Gist

O Agni, the rivers, deathless, unharmed, full of sweet waters and divine in nature, gain power through the help of the sacrifice and always flow swiftly, like a horse that has been urged on.

English translation

By sacrifice, Agni, the divine rivers, immortal, unobstructed, continue perpetually to flow with sweet waters, like a horse that is being urged in his speed.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मा कस्य॑ य॒क्षं सद॒मिद्धु॒रो गा॒ मा वे॒शस्य॑ प्रमि॒न
तो मापेः ।
मा भ्रातु॑रग्ने॒ अनृ॑जोरृ॒णं वे॒र्मा सख्यु॒र्दक्षं॑ रि॒पोर्भु॑जेम
॥ १३ ॥

> *mā kasya yakṣaṃ sadamiddhuro gā mā veśasya praminato māpeḥ* |
> *mā bhrāturagne anṛjorṛṇaṃ vermā sakhyurdakṣaṃ riporbhujema* ‖ *13* ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> मा । कस्य । यक्षं । सदं । इत् । हुरः । गाः । मा । वेशस्य । प्रमिनतः । मा । आपेः ।
> मा । भ्रातुः । अग्ने । अनृजोः । ऋणं । वेः । मा । सख्युः । दक्षं । रिपोः । भुजेम ॥

> *mā* | *kasya* | *yakṣaṃ* | *sadaṃ* | *it* | *huraḥ* | *gāḥ* | *mā* | *veśasya* |
> *praminataḥ* | *mā* | *āpeḥ* |
> *mā* | *bhrātuḥ* | *agne* | *anṛjoḥ* | *ṛṇaṃ* | *veḥ* | *mā* | *sakhyuḥ* | *dakṣaṃ* |
> *ripoḥ* | *bhujema* ‖

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने हुरोऽस्माकं हिंसकस्य कस्य कस्यचिदपि जंतोर्यक्षं यज्ञं सदमित्सदैव मा गाः ।
> कदाचिदपि मा गच्छ । प्रमिनतो हिंसकस्य वेशस्य प्रातिवेश्यस्य
> यज्ञं मा गाः । तथापेर्मद्व्यतिरिक्तस्य बंधोर्यज्ञं मा गच्छ । तथानृजोः
> कुटिलचित्तस्य भ्रातुर्ऋणवद्देयं हविर्मा वेः । मा कामयेथाः । तथा वयमपि
> सख्युर्मित्रस्य रिपोः शत्रोर्दक्षं भोगसमर्थं धनं मा भुजेम । मा भुंजीमहि । किंतु त्वया दत्तं धनं
> भुंजीमहि ॥ हुरः । हृ प्रसह्यकरणे । क्विप् । बहुलं
> छंदसीत्युत्वं । सावेकाच इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । भुजेम । भुज पालनाभ्यवहारयोः ।
> आशीर्लिंजु व्यत्ययेन परस्मैपदं । लिज्याशिष्यज्ञत्यज् प्रत्ययः ॥

> *he agne huro 'smākaṃ hiṃsakasya kasya kasyacidapi jaṃtoryakṣaṃ*
> *yajñaṃ sadamitsadaiva mā gāḥ | kadācidapi mā gaccha | praminato*
> *hiṃsakasya veśasya prātiveśyasya*
> *yajñaṃ mā gāḥ | tathāpermadvyatiriktasya baṃdhoryajñaṃ mā gaccha*
> *| tathānṛjoḥ*
> *kuṭilacittasya bhrāturṛṇavaddeyaṃ havirmā veḥ | mā kāmayethāḥ |*
> *tathā vayamapi*
> *sakhyurmitrasya ripoḥ śatrordakṣaṃ bhogasamarthaṃ dhanaṃ mā*
> *bhujema | mā bhuṃjīmahi | kiṃtu tvayā dattaṃ dhanaṃ bhuṃjīmahi ‖*
> *huraḥ | hṛ prasahyakaraṇe | kvip | bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasītyutvaṃ | sāvekāca iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | bhujema | bhuja*
> *pālanābhyavahārayoḥ | āśīrliju vyatyayena parasmaipadaṃ |*
> *lijyāśiṣyajjatyaj pratyayaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, never go (मा गाः (*mā gāḥ*)) to the sacrifice (यक्षं (*yakṣaṃ*)) of any creature whatever that is हुरः (*huraḥ*), a harmer of us. Do not go to the sacrifice of a harmful neighbour (वेशस्य (*veśasya*), a प्रातिवेश्य (*prātiveśya*)). Likewise do not go to the sacrifice of a kinsman (आपेः (*āpeḥ*)) other than myself. Do not desire (मा वेः (*mā veḥ*)) the oblation due like a debt from a crooked-minded brother (अनृजोः (*anṛjoḥ*)). So too may we not enjoy (मा भुजेम (*mā bhujema*)) the wealth, able to be enjoyed (दक्षं (*dakṣaṃ*)), of a friend's enemy; rather may we enjoy the wealth given by you. The rest of the block is grammar on हुरः (*huraḥ*) and भुजेम (*bhujema*).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- हुरः (*huraḥ*)—who is a harmer of us
- कस्य (*kasya*)—of whichever sacrificer
- यक्षं (*yakṣaṃ*)—to the sacrifice
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—ever
- मा गाः (*mā gāḥ*)—do not go
- प्रमिनतः (*praminataḥ*)—who is harmful
- वेशस्य (*veśasya*)—of the sacrificer next door
- मा (*mā*)—do not go to his sacrifice either
- आपेः (*āpeḥ*)—even if a relative of mine, if he is hostile
- मा (*mā*)—do not go to him either
- अनृजोः (*anṛjoḥ*)—who is deceitful
- भ्रातुः (*bhrātuḥ*)—of him, though my brother
- ऋणं (*ṛṇaṃ*)—the oblation
- मा वेः (*mā veḥ*)—do not desire
- सख्युः (*sakhyuḥ*)—to my friend
- रिपोः (*ripoḥ*)—of him who is an enemy
- दक्षं (*dakṣaṃ*)—the wealth of enjoyment
- मा भुजेम (*mā bhujema*)—may we not enjoy it

Gist

O Agni, never go to the sacrifice of a sacrificer who is a harmer of us. Even if he is our next-door neighbour, if he is harmful and deceitful, do not go there either. Even if he is our brother, do not covet his oblation. We do not want the wealth of enjoyment of one who is an enemy to my friend.

English translation

Go not ever, Agni, to the sacrifice of any one who injures us ; nor to that of a malevolent neighbour; nor to that of an (unnatural) relation ; accept 750 ಸಾಯಣಭಾಷ್ಯಸಹಿತಾ [ಮಂ. ೪. ಅ. ೧ ಸೂ. ೩. not the due (oblation) from an insincere brother ; let us not derive enjoyment from the enemy of a friend.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

रक्षा॑ णो अग्ने॒ तव॒ रक्ष॑णेभी रारक्षा॒णः सु॑मख प्रीणा॒नः ।
प्रति॑ ष्फुर॒ वि रु॑ज वी॒ड्वंहो॑ ज॒हि रक्षो॒ महि॑ चिद्वावृधा॒नम् ॥ १४ ॥

> *rakṣā ṇo agne tava rakṣaṇebhī rārakṣāṇaḥ sumakha prīṇānaḥ |*
> *prati ṣphura vi ruja vīḍvaṃho jahi rakṣo mahi cidvāvṛdhānam ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> रक्ष । नः । अग्ने । तव । रक्षणेभिः । ररक्षणाणः । सुमुख । प्रीणानः ।
> प्रति । स्फुर । वि । रुज । वीळु । अंहः । जहि । रक्षः । महि । चित् । ववृधानं ॥ १४ ॥

> *rakṣa | naḥ | agne | tava | rakṣaṇebhiḥ | rarakṣaṇāṇaḥ | sumukha | prīṇānaḥ |*
> *prati | sphura | vi | ruja | vīḷu | aṃhaḥ | jahi | rakṣaḥ | mahi | cit | vavṛdhānaṃ ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सुमख सुयज्ञ सुधनेति वा हे अग्ने ररक्षणाऽभ्यशमस्माकं रक्षिता
> प्रीणानो हविर्भिः प्रीतस्त्वं तव रक्षणेभिस्त्वदीयैरवनैनोर्नोऽस्मान्रक्ष । पालय ।
> प्रति स्फुर । अस्मान्प्रतिदीप्यस्व । वीळु दृढमंहः पापं वि रुज । विशेषेण नाशय ।
> किंच महि चिन्महदपि वावृधानं वर्धमानं वृद्धं वा बाधकं रक्षो जहि ॥ णः ।
> नश्च धातुस्थोरुषुभ्य इति संहितायां णत्वं । ररक्षणाः । रक्षेर्यज्लुकि चानशि
> रूपं ! जहि । हन हिंसागत्योः । लोटि हंतेर्ज इति जादेशः । आभाच्छास्त्रीयस्यासिद्धत्वादतो
> हेरिति लुक् न भवति ॥

> *sumakha suyajña sudhaneti vā he agne rarakṣaṇā 'bhyaśamasmākaṃ rakṣitā*
> *prīṇāno havirbhiḥ prītastvaṃ tava rakṣaṇebhistvadīyairavanainorno 'smānrakṣa | pālaya |*
> *prati sphura | asmānpratidīpyasva | vīḷu dṛḍhamaṃhaḥ pāpaṃ vi ruja |*

> *viśeṣeṇa nāśaya |*
> *kiṃca mahi cinmahadapi vāvṛdhānaṃ vardhamānaṃ vṛddhaṃ vā*
> *bādhakaṃ rakṣo jahi ‖ ṇaḥ |*
> *naśca dhātusthoruṣubhya iti saṃhitāyāṃ ṇatvaṃ | rarakṣaṇāḥ |*
> *rakṣeryajluki cānaśi*
> *rūpaṃ ! jahi | hana hiṃsāgatyoḥ | loṭi haṃterja iti jādeśaḥ |*
> *ābhācchāstrīyasyāsiddhatvādato heriti luk na bhavati ‖*

Summary

O Agni, सुमख (*sumakha*) ("of good sacrifice"; or "of good wealth", with the alternative readings सुयज्ञ (*suyajña*) and सुधन (*sudhana*)), you are ररक्षणाः (*rarakṣaṇāḥ*), our protector, and प्रीणानः (*prīṇānaḥ*), pleased with the oblations. With your protections protect and guard us. प्रति स्फुर (*prati sphura*): shine towards us. अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*) is sin; वीळु (*vīḷu*) means "firm"; वि रुज (*vi ruja*): destroy it specially. Further, slay (जहि (*jahi*)) the Rākṣasa who obstructs us, even though he is great and growing or grown strong (वावृधानं (*vāvṛdhānaṃ*)). The rest is grammar on णः (*ṇaḥ*), ररक्षणाः (*rarakṣaṇāḥ*) and जहि (*jahi*).

Word-to-word meaning

- सुमख (*sumakha*)—you who have a good sacrifice
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ररक्षणाः (*rarakṣaṇāḥ*)—as our protector
- प्रीणानः (*prīṇānaḥ*)—as one pleased with oblations
- तव (*tava*)—your
- रक्षणेभिः (*rakṣaṇebhiḥ*)—with protections
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- रक्ष (*rakṣa*)—protect
- प्रति स्फुर (*prati sphura*)—shine on our behalf
- वीळु (*vīḷu*)—firmly rooted
- अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*)—sin
- वि रुज (*vi ruja*)—destroy
- वावृधानः (*vāvṛdhānaḥ*)—who harms excessively
- रक्षः (*rakṣaḥ*)—the enemy
- महि जत् (*mahi jat*)—even when powerful[?373]
- जहि (*jahi*)—destroy

Gist

O Agni, of good sacrifice, being our protector and pleased with the oblations, preserve us with your protections. Shine on our behalf. Destroy our sin, firmly planted. Crush the enemy who harms us, even though he is powerful.

English translation

Agni, worthily worshipped, conservator, conciliated (by our offerings), protect us with your protections : enlighten us ; entirely extirpate our sin ; overcome the great and exulting Rakshasas.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒भिर्भ॑व सु॒मना॑ अग्ने अ॒र्कैरि॒मान्स्पृ॑श॒ मन्म॑भिः शूर॒ वाजा॑न् ।
उ॒त ब्रह्मा॑ण्यङ्गिरो जुषस्व॒ सं ते॑ श॒स्तिर्दे॒ववा॑ता जरेत ॥ १५ ॥

> *ebhirbhava sumanā agne arkairimānspṛśa manmabhiḥ śūra vājān |*
> *uta brahmāṇyaṅgiro juṣasva saṃ te śastirdevavātā jareta ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एभिः । भव । सुमनाः । अग्ने । अर्कैः । इमान् । स्पृश । मन्मभिः । शूर । वाजान् ।
> उत । ब्रह्माणि । अंगिरः । जुषस्व । सम् । ते । शस्तिः । देववाता । जरेत ॥ १५ ॥

> *ebhiḥ | bhava | sumanāḥ | agne | arkaiḥ | imān | spṛśa | manmabhiḥ | śūra | vājān |*
> *uta | brahmāṇi | aṃgiraḥ | juṣasva | sam | te | śastiḥ | devavātā | jareta ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने एभिर्मधीयैरर्कैरर्चनीयैः शस्त्रैः सुमनाः शोभनमनस्को
> भव । हे शूर इमानस्मदीयान्विर्लक्षणान्वाजान्मन्मभिः स्तोत्रैः सह स्पृश । प्रतिगृहाण ।
> उतापि च अंगिरः । अंगति हवींषि प्राप्नोतीत्यंगिरा अग्निः । यद्वा ।
> येऽंगारा आसंस्तेऽंगिरसोऽभवन् । ऐ. ब्रा. ३–३४ । इति ब्राह्मणं । तेषामंगिरसां
> कारणत्वादग्नेरंगिरस्त्वं । तत्कारणत्वे च मंत्रः । ये अंगिरसः सूनवस्ते अग्नेः
> परि जज्ञिरे । ऋग्वे. १८–६२–५ । इति । तादृश हे अग्ने ब्रह्माणि मंत्रान् जुषस्व ।
> सेवस्व । देववाता । देवार्थं गता देवान् स्तोतुं प्राप्तेत्यर्थः । तादृशी शक्तिः

> *he agne ebhirmadhīyairarkèrarcanīyaiḥ śastraiḥ sumanāḥ śobhanamanasko*
> *bhava | he śūra imānasmadīyānvirlakṣaṇānvājānmanmabhiḥ stotraiḥ saha spṛśa | pratigṛhāṇa | utāpi ca aṃgiraḥ | aṃgati havīṃṣi prāpnotītyaṃgirā agniḥ | yadvā |*
> *ye 'ṃgārā āsaṃste 'ṃgiraso 'bhavan | ai. brā. 3-34 | iti brāhmaṇaṃ | teṣāmaṃgirasāṃ kāraṇatvādagneraṃgirastvaṃ | tatkāraṇatve ca maṃtraḥ | ye aṃgirasaḥ sūnavaste agneḥ*
> *pari jajjire | ṛgve. 18-62-5 | iti | tādṛśa he agne brahmāṇi maṃtrān juṣasva |*
> *sevasva | devavātā | devārthaṃ gatā devān stotuṃ prāptetyarthaḥ | tādṛśī śaktiḥ*

> शंसनं ते त्वां सं जरेत । संवर्धयतु ॥ स्पृश । स्पृश संस्पर्शने । तुदादिः ।
> देवनाता । वा गतिगंधनयोः । गत्यर्थाकर्मकेति कर्तरि क्तः । देवः । पचाद्यजंतः । क्ले चेति
> चतुर्थ्यंतस्य पदस्य प्रकृतिस्वरः ॥

> *śaṃsanaṃ te tvāṃ saṃ jareta | saṃvardhayatu ‖ spṛśa | spṛśa saṃsparśane | tudādiḥ |*
> *devanātā | vā gatigaṃdhanayoḥ | gatyarthākarmaketi kartari ktaḥ | devaḥ | pacādyajaṃtaḥ | kle ceti caturthyaṃtasya padasya prakṛtisvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, be well-minded, of good mind, through these (एभिः (*ebhiḥ*)) hymns of praise (अर्कैः (*arkaiḥ*), "to be worshipped with"), belonging to us. O hero, receive these (इमान् (*imān*)) food-offerings (वाजान् (*vājān*)) of ours together with our praises (मन्मभिः (*manmabhiḥ*)): स्पृश (*spṛśa*) means "accept". And, O अंगिरः (*aṃgiraḥ*): Agni is अंगिराः (*aṃgirāḥ*)

because he अंगति (*aṃgati*), that is, reaches the oblations. Or else, there is the Brāhmaṇa: येऽंगारा आसंस्तेऽंगिरसोऽभवन् (*ye 'ṃgārā āsaṃste 'ṃgiraso 'bhavan*) (Ai. Brā. 3-34)[?374]. Because those Aṅgirases are the cause, Agni is called Aṅgiras. For his being their cause there is the mantra ये अंगिरसः सूनवस्ते अग्नेः परि जज्ञिरे । (*ye aṃgirasaḥ sūnavaste agneḥ pari jajjire* |) (Ṛgve. 18-62-5)[?375]. Such as you are, O Agni, accept (जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)) our mantras (ब्रह्माणि (*brahmāṇi*)), that is, attend to them. देववाता (*devavātā*) means gone for the sake of the gods, come to praise the gods. Such a power, the शस्तिः (*śastiḥ*) ("praise"), shall make you grow (सं जरेत (*saṃ jareta*): let it increase you).

The block continues with grammar on स्पृश (*spṛśa*) (root स्पृश (*spṛśa*), "to touch", of the tud class) and on देवनाता (*devanātā*) (root वा (*vā*) "to go, to move"; the suffix kta in the active sense; देवः (*devaḥ*) ends in ac of the pac class; the accent of the dative-ending word is the natural one).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- एभिः अर्कैः (*ebhiḥ arkaiḥ*)—with these revered śastra-mantras
- सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*)—having an auspicious mind
- भव (*bhava*)—be
- शूर (*śūra*)—O mighty one
- इमान् वाजान् (*imān vājān*)—these foods in the form of oblations
- मन्मभिः (*manmabhiḥ*)—with our praises
- स्पृश (*spṛśa*)—accept
- उत (*uta*)—and
- अंगिरः (*aṃgiraḥ*)—O Agni
- ब्रह्माणि (*brahmāṇi*)—the mantras
- जुषस्व (*juṣasva*)—attend to
- देवताता (*devatātā*)—addressed to the gods[?376]
- शस्तिः (*śastiḥ*)—praise
- ते (*te*)—you[?377]
- सं जरेत (*saṃ jareta*)—let it make grow

Gist

O Agni, be of auspicious mind through these revered śastra-mantras. O mighty one, accept these foods in the form of oblations together with our praises. And, O Agni who are in the form of Aṅgiras, attend to these mantras of ours. May this praise, addressed to the gods, make you grow.

English translation

Be propitiated, Agni, by these hymns ; accept, hero, these (sacrificial) viands (presented) with praises ; be pleased, Angiras, by our prayers; may the adoration addressed to the gods exalt you.

Special Topics

In this hymn, and in many other Ṛks of the Ṛgveda, the word अंगिरः (*aṃgiraḥ*) is used to address Agni. An explanation of this is needed. येऽङ्गारा आसंस्तेऽङ्गरसोऽभवन् (*ye 'ṅgārā āsaṃste 'ṅgaraso 'bhavan*) (Ai. Brā. 3-34): "the embers (coals) connected with Agni received the name Aṅgirases." So it is said in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa, in the story of Prajāpati's meditation on his daughter. Long ago Prajāpati (Brahmā) contemplated in his mind his own daughter (Uṣas, or the sky) with a bad intention (lust). The gods came to know it and thought of preventing this evil deed. But the gods had no power to punish Prajāpati and restrain him from it. So all the gods gathered together, united their several dreadful forms, brought forth a god named Rudra, and told him to punish Prajāpati. Knowing this, Prajāpati became afraid, took the form of a deer and leapt into the sky. . . .

Prajāpati, in the form of the constellation called Mṛga, can be seen even now. Then Rudra appeared in the form of the constellation Ārdrā and shot an arrow at Prajāpati. Then Prajāpati had an emission of seed. The Maruts scattered that seed in various directions and burnt it. From it (from that seed) first Āditya was born, and afterwards Bhṛgu Vāruṇi. From the remaining embers (coals) the Aṅgirases came into being. So it is said.

In the Purāṇas and elsewhere the sage Aṅgirā is said to be one of the mind-born sons of Brahmā. In the Vedas this Aṅgiras is a very important sage and the original ancestor of many famous sages. The matter is found in the Vana Parva of the Mahābhārata, in the dialogue of Mārkaṇḍeya and Yudhiṣṭhira. For some reason Agni abandoned his duty and went off to the forest in disguise. Then the sage Aṅgirā, in Agni's place, did Agni's work, carrying the shares of oblation to the gods in the sacrifice. He also prayed to Agni to return and perform his duty. Because he performed Agni's duties, this sage Aṅgirā became known as Agni's son, and the descendants of this sage became known as Aṅgirases.

There are some more such stories in the Purāṇas. Besides these, in the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā itself: ते अंगिरसः सूनवस्ते अग्नेः परिजज्ञिरे । (*te aṃgirasaḥ sūnavaste agneḥ parijajjire |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-62-5), that is, it is clearly said that the sages called Aṅgirases are sons of Agni. It is not known why the commentator did not quote this Ṛk.

It is evident from some Ṛks of the Ṛgveda that this sage Aṅgirā was of very ancient time and that many sages of the Ṛgveda here and there call him the original ancestor of their line.

मनुष्पदग्ने अंगिरस्वदंगिरो ययातिवत्सदने पूर्ववच्चुचे ॥ (*manuṣpadagne aṃgirasvadaṃgiro yayātivatsadane pūrvavaccuce ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-31-17)

अंगिरस्वन्नहिव्रत प्रस्कण्वस्य श्रुधी हवं (*aṃgirasvannahivrata praskaṇvasya śrudhī havaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-45-3)

दध्यज् ह मे जनुषं पूर्वो अंगिराः प्रियमेधः कण्वो अत्रिर्मनुर्वि दुस्ते मे पूर्वे मनुर्विदुः ॥ (*dadhyaj ha me januṣaṃ pūrvo aṃgirāḥ priyamedhaḥ kaṇvo atrirmanurvi duste me pūrve manurviduḥ ||*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-139-9)

These Ṛks show that the sage Aṅgirā was the forefather of many sages. Among the descendants of this sage Aṅgirā, Atharvan was the chief. He had three sons, Bṛhaspati, Gotama and Vṛṣaṇa. Vṛṣaṇa was a son born to this Atharvan by his wife named Pathyā. His affairs are indicated in many places in the Veda. Vṛṣaṇa's son was Sudhanvan Āṅgirasa, and this Sudhanvan had three sons, Ṛbhu, Vibhvan and Vāja. These three are spoken of in the Veda as the Ṛbhus. They are said to be pupils of Tvaṣṭā Prajāpati. In the line of this sage Aṅgirā there were three sages named Bṛhaspati. The Ṛbhus mentioned above and Bṛhaspati are regarded as gods, and there are many Ṛks of the Ṛgveda in the form of praises of them. History records that the first of these three Bṛhaspatis killed a Dasyu king named Paṇi and brought back the cows that he had carried off, and that he fought and defeated, with his ten thousand followers, another Dasyu chief named Dāsa who was ruling on the bank of the river Aṃśumatī. The sage Bharadvāja, son of another Bṛhaspati, was the priest of Divodāsa, who slew the demon Śambara. In short, the line of the sage Aṅgirā is very great, and many famous men belonged to it. In many places in the Ṛgveda, that is, in many places where the word Agni would have to be used, the use of the word Aṅgiras is frequent.

The story set out in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa (Ai. Brā. 13-23, 24) is given here exactly as it is told there:

प्रजाप्रतिर्नै स्वां दुहितरमभ्यध्यायद्दिवमित्यन्य आहुरुषसमित्कन्ये तामृश्यो भूत्वा रोहितं भूतामभ्यैत्तं देवा अपश्यन्नकृतं वै प्रजापतिः करोतीति ते तम्मैच्छन्य एनमारिष्यत्येतमन्योन्यस्मिन्नाविंदंस्तेषां या एन घोरतमास्तन्व आसंस्ता एकधा समभरंस्ताः संभृता एष देवोऽभवत्तदस्यैतद्भूतवन्नाम भवति वै स योऽस्यैतदेवं नाम वेद ॥ (*prajāpratirnai svāṃ duhitaramabhyadhyāyaddivamityanya āhuruṣasamitkanye tāmṛśyo bhūtvā rohitaṃ bhūtāmabhyaittaṃ devā apaśyannakṛtaṃ vai prajāpatiḥ karotīti te tammaicchanya enamāriṣyatyetamanyonyasminnāviṃdaṃsteṣāṃ yā ena ghoratamāstanva āsaṃstā ekadhā samabharaṃstāḥ saṃbhṛtā eṣa devo 'bhavattadasyaitadbhūtavannāma bhavati vai sa yo 'syaitadevaṃ nāma veda* ‖) (Ai. Brā. 13-33)[?378]

Long ago, at one time, Prajāpati saw his own daughter and was infatuated, as one is infatuated with a wife. He kept thinking of her form in his mind. As to who that daughter of Prajāpati was, there is a difference of opinion even among the great sages. Some say she was the deity of the sky-world, others that she was the deity Uṣas. Be that as it may. Then Prajāpati took the form of a kind of deer (animal) called Ṛśya. His daughter took the form of a red deer called Rohita. (Here the commentator explains the words रोहितं प्राप्ता (*rohitaṃ prāptā*) as "she became fit for conception".) Prajāpati approached his daughter, who was in the form of Rohita, . . .

…became intent on the act of union. Seeing Prajāpati thus attached to his own daughter and bent on intercourse, the gods spoke among themselves: "This Prajāpati is engaged in a forbidden act that no one has ever done. Who is the person able to stop this deed from taking place?" They searched everywhere. However much they searched, no person capable of restraining Prajāpati was found. The gods put the question to each one among themselves: "If you have the strength, slay Prajāpati." None of them seemed to have that power. Then all the gods together gathered their dreadful forms (it is well known that the gods can assume any form they like; hence "leaving their gentle forms, dreadful shapes" is said here) into one, and created a single person of most dreadful shape. This person received the name Rudra. Hence the names Bhūtavat and Bhūtapati are well known in the world for Rudra. So a person who has taken on this state of being "bhūtavat" of Rudra becomes bhūtimat (prosperous).

तं देवा अब्रुवन्नयं वै प्रजापतिरकृतमकरिमं विध्येति स तथेत्यब्रवीत्स वै वो वरं वृणा इति वृणीष्वेति स एतमेव वरमवृणीत पशूनामाधिपत्यं तदस्यैतत्पशुमन्नाम पशुमान्भवति योऽस्यैतदेवं नाम वेद । (*taṃ devā abruvannayaṃ vai prajāpatirakṛtamakarimaṃ vidhyeti sa tathetyabravītsa vai vo varaṃ vṛṇā iti vṛṇīṣṭeti sa etameva varamavṛṇīta paśūnāmādhipatyaṃ tadasyaitatpaśumannāma paśumānbhavati yo 'syaitadevaṃ nāma veda |*) (Ai. Brā. 13-23)

Then the gods addressed that person (Rudra): "O Rudra, Prajāpati has done a forbidden deed. Therefore, to punish him, strike him with this arrow." Rudra agreed that it should be so. But he asked as a boon that he should become the lord of all animals. The gods gave him the boon accordingly. Therefore Rudra became famous by the name Paśupati. The person who knows this obtains wealth of cattle.

तमभ्यायत्याविध्यत्स विद्ध ऊर्ध्व उदप्रपतत्तमेतं मृग इत्याचक्षते य उ एव मृगव्याधः स उ एव स या रोहित्सा रोहिणी यो एवेषुस्त्रिकांडा सो एवेषुस्त्रिकांडा । (*tamabhyāyatyāvidhyatsa viddha ūrdhva udaprapatattametaṃ mṛga ityācakṣate ya u eva mṛgavyādhaḥ sa u eva sa yā rohitsā rohiṇī yo eveṣustrikāṃḍā so eveṣustrikāṃḍā |*)

Then Rudra came forward, strung his bow, fitted the arrow, drew it back, aimed at Prajāpati and shot. The arrow struck Prajāpati, who was in the form of an ṛśya, and he leapt upward into the atmosphere. Seeing Prajāpati leaping upward in the sky, all people call it the constellation Mṛga (Stars in the Orion). That is, they say it is the Mṛgaśīrṣa star between the stars Rohiṇī and Ārdrā.

The meaning is that Prajāpati exists in the form of a star. Rudra, who shot Prajāpati in the form of a deer with the arrow, appears in the sky by the name Mṛgavyādha. The daughter of Prajāpati, in the form of the red doe called rohita, appears in the sky as the star Rohiṇī. The arrow sent by Rudra came to have three parts: the kāṇḍa (the long shaft of the arrow), the śalya (the barb) and the tip (the sharp point); therefore the arrow has these three parts even now.

तद्वा इदं प्रजापते रेतः सिक्तमधावत्तत्सरोऽभवत्ते देवा अब्रुवन्मेदं प्रजापते रेतो दुषदिति यदब्रुवन्मेदं प्रजापते रेतो दुषदिति तन्मादुषमभवत्तन्मामहस्य मादुषत्वं मादुषं ह वै नामैतद्यन्मानुषं सन्मानुषमित्याचक्षरे परोक्षेण परोक्षप्रिया इव हि देवाः (*tadvā idaṃ prajāpate retaḥ siktamadhāvattatsaro 'bhavatte devā abruvanmedaṃ prajāpate reto duṣaditi yadabruvanmedaṃ prajāpate reto duṣaditi tanmāduṣamabhavattanmāmahasya māduṣatvaṃ māduṣaṃ ha vai nāmaitadyanmānuṣaṃ sanmānuṣamityācakṣare parokṣeṇa parokṣapriyā iva hi devāḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 13-23)

The semen (seed) of Prajāpati in deer form was abundant; part of it was shed into his daughter, the doe, and the remainder fell on the earth, began to flow like a river in a stream, collected in a low-lying place and became a great lake. Seeing it, the gods wished that people should not think this seed of Prajāpati untouchable (not to be touched) or "mādūṣat", bad. Because the gods called it mādūṣat, the lake, which was the seed of the faultless Prajāpati, came to be named Mādūṣat. People substitute the letter na in place of the da of the word mādūṣa when reciting, and so they call Brahmins, Kṣatriyas and other people "mānuṣa". Rightly considered, the word mānuṣa (mādūṣa) means "faultless". That being so, instead of referring to their bodies by the word mānuṣa of ordinary meaning, people refer to them by a word of indirect meaning (that is, with the excellent sense of mādūṣa); therefore worthy and worshipful persons, like the gods, in worldly usage are fond of the indirect (content with words that have a hidden sense rather than a directly evident one). For example, they are satisfied not so much with the ordinary names, such as Devadatta, given by their parents, as with names suited to their nature, such as Upādhyāya, Ācārya, Svāmin, which make their fame shine. The gods too, not appearing directly but remaining out of sight, accept praises and the like; therefore it is said that the gods are fond of the indirect. So, to show indirectness, in the word mādūṣa the na is put in place of the da and mānuṣa is used.

तदग्निना पर्यादधुस्तन्मरुतोऽधून्वंस्तदग्निर्न प्राच्यावयत्तदग्निना वैश्वानरेण पर्यादधुस्तस्मरुतोऽधून्वंस्तदग्निर्वृश्वानरः प्राच्यावयत्तस्य यद्रेतसः प्रथममुददीप्यत तदसावादित्योऽभवद्यद्वितीयमासीत्तद्भृगुरभवत्तं वरुणो न्यगृह्णीत तस्मात्स भृगुर्वारुणिरथ यत्कृतीयमदीदेदिव त आदित्या अभवन्येऽङ्गारा आसंस्तेऽङ्गरसोऽभवन्यदंगाराः पुनरवशांता उददीप्यंत तद्ब्रहस्पतिरभवत् । (*tadagninā paryādadhustanmaruto 'dhūnvaṃstadagnirna prācyāvayattadagninā vaiśvānareṇa paryādadhustasmaruto 'dhūnvaṃstadagnirvṛśvānaraḥ prācyāvayattasya yadretasaḥ prathamamudadīpyata tadasāvādityo 'bhavadyadvitīyamāsīttadbhṛgurabhavattaṃ varuṇo nyagṛhṇīta tasmātsa bhṛgurvāruṇiratha yatkṛtīyamadīdediva ta ādityā abhavanye 'ṅgārā āsaṃste 'ṅgaraso 'bhavanyadaṃgārāḥ punaravaśāṃtā udadīpyaṃta tadbrahaspatirabhavat |*) (Ai. Brā. 13-34)

Then, after the gods had made the seed of Prajāpati faultless, they thought that this seed, which was in liquid form as a lake, must be made free of liquid; they kindled fire around the lake and began to burn it. While the fire was blazing all around the lake, the wind churned the seed into turmoil in order to dry up the liquid mixed with it. Yet the fire could not, by its heat, remove the liquid state, which was very strong in the seed, and turn it into a lump (a solid, hard substance). Therefore the gods tried to accomplish, by a special form of fire named Vaiśvānara, this work that the fire could not do. This Vaiśvānara fire enters the bellies of all beings as the digestive fire and is engaged in digesting food and drink.

अहं वैश्वानरो भूत्वा प्राणिनां देहमाश्रितः । प्राणापानसमायुक्तः पचाम्यन्नं चतुर्विधं ॥ (*ahaṃ vaiśvānaro bhūtvā prāṇināṃ dehamāśritaḥ | prāṇāpānasamāyuktaḥ pacāmyannaṃ caturvidhaṃ ‖*)

"Becoming the Vaiśvānara fire, abiding in the bodies of beings, joined with the breaths prāṇa and apāna, I digest the fourfold food that beings eat" — so the Lord himself has said. Therefore the gods, knowing that the power of the Vaiśvānara fire is special, set the

Vaiśvānara fire around the lake to dry up that seed of Prajāpati. The wind too entered the lake as before, churned it into turmoil and began to dry it. Thus, with the help of the wind, the Vaiśvānara fire separated the seed of Prajāpati from its liquid state and turned it into a solid, lump-shaped substance. Thus the seed, turned into many lumps (spherical), began to blaze and shine. Of these, the first lump, a mass of radiance, became the Āditya seen in heaven (the sky). The second lump became the sage Bhṛgu. Varuṇa accepted this Bhṛgu as his son. Therefore the sage Bhṛgu got the name Bhṛgurvāruṇiḥ, "the sage Bhṛgu, son of Varuṇa"; as the son of Varuṇa he is also called Vāruṇi. With this in mind the followers of the Taittirīya branch recite: भृगुर्वैवारुणिः । वरुणं पितरमुपससार (*bhṛgurvaivāruṇiḥ | varuṇaṃ pitaramupasasāra*) (Tai. U. 3-1). Then the third lump, shining exceedingly,

became famous as the sons of Aditi, by the name Ādityas. Āditya means the sun within the orb. It is to be understood that here the word ādityāḥ indicates the other gods, sons of Aditi. Then some other lumps burned well (were consumed) and became embers. From those embers arose the sages called Aṅgiras. And from the embers that were still burning and had not gone out, that is, that began to burn brightly again and again, Bṛhaspati arose.

यानि परिक्षाणान्यासंस्ते कृष्णाः पशवोऽभवन्या लोहिनी मृत्तिका ते रोहिता अथ यद्भस्मासीत्तत्परुष्यं व्यसर्पद्गौरो गवय ऋश्य उष्टो गर्दभ इति ये चैतेऽरुणाः पशवस्ते च । (*yāni parikṣāṇānyāsaṃste kṛṣṇāḥ paśavo 'bhavanyā lohinī mṛttikā te rohitā atha yadbhasmāsīttatparuṣyaṃ vyasarpadgauro gavaya ṛśya uṣṭo gardabha iti ye caite 'ruṇāḥ paśavaste ca |*) (Ai. Brā. 13-34)

Then, when the embers went out and became aṅgāra (charcoal), these became black animals. After the fire had burned, the red clay (earth) lying at the bottom became red animals. From the ashes (bhasma) arose the paruṣya animals, that is, the forest animals gaura, gavaya and ṛśya, and also the camel and the donkey. And so on. By this narrative, the account of the origin of the Aṅgiras sages, the relation between the Aṅgiras sages and Agni, and the reason why Agni got the name Aṅgiras are all explained.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒ता विश्वा॑ वि॒दुषे॒ तु॒भ्यं॑ वेधो नी॒थान्य॑ग्ने नि॒ण्या व॒चां॑सि ।
नि॒वच॑ना क॒वये॒ काव्या॒न्यशं॑सिषं म॒तिभि॒र्विप्र॑ उ॒क्थैः ॥ १६ ॥

> *etā viśvā viduṣe tubhyaṃ vedho nīthānyagne niṇyā vacāṃsi |*
> *nivacanā kavaye kāvyānyaśaṃsiṣaṃ matibhirvipra ukthaiḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एता । निश्वा । विदुषे । तुभ्यं । वेधः । नीथानि । अग्ने । निज्या । वचांसि ।
> निऽवचना । कवये । काव्यानि । अशंसिषं । मतिभिः । विप्रः । उक्तैः ॥ १६ ॥

> *etā | niśvā | viduṣe | tubhyaṃ | vedhaḥ | nīthāni | agne | nijyā | vacāṃsi |*
> *ni 'vacanā | kavaye | kāvyāni | aśaṃsiṣaṃ | matibhiḥ | vipraḥ | uktaiḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वेधो विधातर्हे अग्ने विदुषे कर्मविषयज्ञानवते कवये क्रांतदर्शिने
> तुभ्यं नीथानि फलप्रापकाणि निण्या नेयार्थानि गूढानि निवचना नितरां वक्तव्यानि
> काव्यानि कविभिर्मेधाविभिः कृतान्येता विश्वैतानि सर्वाणि वचांसि वाक्यानि मतिभिर्म–

> *vedho vidhātarhe agne viduṣe karmaviṣayajñānavate kavaye krāṃtadarśine*
> *tubhyaṃ nīthāni phalaprāpakāṇi niṇyā neyārthāni gūḍhāni nivacanā nitarāṃ vaktavyāni*
> *kāvyāni kavibhirmedhāvibhiḥ kṛtānyetā viśvaitāni sarvāṇi vacāṃsi vākyāni matibhirma-*

> ननीयैः स्तोत्रैरुक्थैः शस्त्रैश्च सहितो विप्रः प्राज्ञोऽहमशंसिषं । अवोचं ।
> तानि सेवस्वेत्यर्थः ।

> *nanīyaiḥ stotrairukthaiḥ śastraiśca sahito vipraḥ prājño 'hamaśaṃsiṣaṃ | avocaṃ |*
> *tāni sevasvetyarthaḥ |*

Summary

"Vedhaḥ" means vidhātaḥ, "O Creator"; the address is to Agni. Vidvas is one who has knowledge concerning ritual action; kavi is one who sees beyond (krāntadarśin). To you, so described, he says, he has recited these words. Nīthāni are those that bring about the fruit; niṇyā are of hidden meaning (neyārtha), obscure; nivacanā are to be spoken constantly; they are poems made by poets, the wise. "These all words" means all these sentences, to be recited with the thoughts (matibhiḥ)… [the explanation continues in the next block].

…with praises worthy of reflection, with ukthas, that is, śastras: "I, the wise one (vipra, prājña), have recited, have spoken; accept them" is the meaning.[?379]

Word-to-word meaning

- वेधः (*vedhaḥ*)—creator
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- विदुषे (*viduṣe*)—one who has knowledge concerning ritual action
- कवये (*kavaye*)—and one who sees beyond
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—to you
- नीथानि (*nīthāni*)—those that bring about the fruit
- निण्या (*niṇyā*)—those of hidden meaning
- निवचना (*nivacanā*)—those worthy of praise
- काव्यानि (*kāvyāni*)—those composed by poets
- एता विश्वा वचांसि (*etā viśvā vacāṃsi*)—all these words of praise too
- मतिभिः (*matibhiḥ*)—with worshipful hymns of praise
- उक्षैः (*ukṣaiḥ*)—with śastra-mantras
- विप्रः (*vipraḥ*)—I, the wise one
- अशंसिषं (*aśaṃsiṣaṃ*)—I recite

Gist

O Agni, creator, to you who have knowledge concerning ritual action and who see beyond, I, the wise one, recite all these words of praise, which bring the fruit, are of hidden meaning, are worthy of praise and are composed by poets, together with worshipful hymns of praise and śastra-mantras.

English translation

Agni, creator, to the who are wise, acquainted with the past, I address oh sage, these soliciting mysterious words, (these) ever-to-be-recited poems, together with praises and prayers.

Sūkta 4 (Maṇḍala 4)

The deity of this sūkta is Agni Rakṣohā; that is, Agni who destroys the host of rakṣas, beings such as ghosts and piśācas that obstruct sacrifices. Explaining the word rakṣaḥ, Yāska has given the etymology:

रक्षो रक्षितव्यमस्मात् । रहसि क्षणोतीति ना । रात्रौ नक्षत इति ना ॥ (*rakṣo rakṣitavyamasmāt | rahasi kṣaṇotīti nā | rātrau nakṣata iti nā ||*) (Ni. 4-8)

That is: the host of beings called rakṣas devours men; from it our body must be protected; because it must be protected from it, it is called rakṣaḥ. Or, because it harms (men) in a solitary place where no one is, or in the dark, it is called rakṣaḥ. Or, because it moves about at night, it is called rakṣaḥ. Thus he has given three kinds of meaning.

There is a difference between the word rakṣaḥ and the word rākṣasa. Rākṣasas are particular persons of human shape, or of other fearful shape that can be seen with the eye. They are of wicked nature, always cause harm to good people and cause obstacles to good deeds. The word rakṣaḥ denotes ghosts, spirits, piśācas and the like that are not visible to the eye (Demons, evil spirits &c.): it is their nature to cause harm to men and to cause the swelling up (of obstruction) to good deeds such as sacrifices. It is customary to pray to Agni in sacrifices and in other rites to remove their affliction and protect us. The Agni who removes this kind of affliction is called Rakṣohā Agni.

The piśācas or bhūtas on the earth are enemies of men. The word that denotes them as a class is rakṣaḥ. This word occurs more than fifty times in the singular and plural; ordinarily it comes together with some deity, in the form of a prayer, "destroy the rākṣasa", or in the form of praise, "you have slain the rākṣasa". In the sūktas 7-104 and 10-87 mention of them is the very subject. Here the words rakṣasaḥ, yātu, yātudhāna and the like indicate them. Since rakṣasaḥ is the name for evil deities, piśācas and all such, it may be understood as the class-name, and yātu as the sub-class name.

These piśācas or bhūtas have the forms of dogs, vultures, owls and other birds (7-104-20 to 22). In bird form they fly about at night (7-104-18). Taking the form of a brother, a husband or a lover, they approach women and wish to destroy their children (10-162-5). In the form of a dog or a monkey they lie in wait to fall upon women (A. Ve. 4-37-11).[?380] Hence pregnant women and children are troubled by them. (A. Ve. 8-6). At the time of marriage they move about around the bride; to pierce their eyes (?) they shoot small arrows into the atmosphere (Mā. Gṛ. Sū. 1-10).[?381] The description of their form and so on is found in the Atharvaveda itself. They in particular take form like men. Mention is made of their limbs, such as head, eyes, heart; but some deformity is always there: three heads, two mouths, four eyes, five feet, no fingers, feet turned backward, or horns on the hands, and so on (A. Ve. 8-6; Hi. Gṛ. Sū. 2-3-7).[?382] Blue, yellow or green piśācas are also mentioned (A. Ve. 19-22-4, 5). Among them also there are males and females, families, and kings (A. Ve. 5-22-12; Hi. Gṛ. Sū. 2-3-7); they too are mortal (A. Ve. 6-32-2; and so on).

The Yātudhānas eat the flesh of men and of horses, and they drink cow's milk (10-86-16, 17). To satisfy their craving for blood and flesh the Rākṣasas attack men. This attack is generally made by entering them. Agni is prayed to keep the Rākṣasas from entering the worshippers (8-48-20). A disease-spirit, a Piśāca flitting hither and thither, enters men (Atha. Saṃ. 7-76-4). These ghosts and spirits generally enter us through our mouth when we eat or drink (Atha. Saṃ. 5-29-6 to 8); they also enter by other openings (Atha. Saṃ. 8-6-3). As soon as they are inside, they tear out and eat the man's flesh and cause disease (Atha. Saṃ. 5-29-5, 10). They cause madness and destroy the power of speech (Atha. Saṃ. 6-1113; Hi. Gṛ. Sū. 1-15-5). They invade men's dwellings (Kau. Sū. 135-9). Some spirits, in the evening, go about the houses dancing and braying like asses, or roam in the forests, or laugh loudly or drink from skulls (Atha. Saṃ. 8-6-10), 11, 14; Hi. Gṛ. Sū. 2-3-3).

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Their time of roaming is night or evening (7-104-8). In the eastern quarter their sport does not go on; the sun rising there drives them away (Tai. Saṃ. 2-6-6.3). A falling meteor is thought to be the form of a spirit (Kau. Sū. 126-9). As the pitch darkness of the new-moon night is fit for the roaming of the departed, so it is the favourable time for the spirits too (Atha. Saṃ. 1-16-1; 4-36-3).

Nothing endangers sacrifices as much as they do. In sacrifices fit for the gods the Piśācas cause defects and omissions, and the Yātus scatter the offered oblations here and there (7-104-18, 21). They cannot bear the sight of praise (10-182-3). Agni is prayed to burn up the spirits and the like, so that no curse may touch the sacrifice (1-76-3). There is a mantra that makes an enemy's sacrifice fail to prosper through the magic of the Yātudhānas and the Rakṣas hosts (Atha. Saṃ. 7-70-2). They come as departed spirits and obstruct the food and water offered to the dead (Atha. Saṃ. 18-2-28; compare Vā. Saṃ. 2-29). In the Purāṇas it is common that these Rakṣas (commonly called Rākṣasas) trouble yogis.

Agni, the dispeller of darkness and the lord of the sacrifice, has a deep hatred of them. Prayer is made to Agni himself: burn them, drive them off, destroy them (10-87-3-6 and so on). It is from this poem that Agni and some other deities have the name "Rakṣohā" (slayer of Rakṣas).

These spirits are not only harmful by nature; they sometimes do harm when impelled by others. The expression rakṣoyujaḥ (those who impel Rākṣasas) is found (6-62-9), and here and there there are the spirits and Yātus of the magicians (7-104-23; 8-60-20). One who is afflicted by a spirit sent by an enemy can drive them away by offering oblation to Agni Yaviṣṭha (Tai. Saṃ. 2-2-3-2); and those spirits themselves are commanded to swallow him who sent them (Atha. Saṃ. 2-2-4).

In the sense of spirits the word rakṣaḥ is used in both the masculine and the feminine; in the neuter it also means danger. It may come from the root rakṣ (to trouble), "harmful"; but this use is very rare. It may also come from the common rakṣ, to protect; in that case rakṣaḥ means "that which is to be guarded against".

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> कृणुष्वेति पंचदशर्चं चतुर्थं सूक्तं नामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभं रक्षोहाग्नि देवताकं । कृणुष्ट पंचोना
> राक्षोघ्नमित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥ प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोः सूक्तविनियोगः ॥ प्रवर्ग्येऽभिष्टवे कृणुष्ट
> पाज इत्याद्याः पंचर्चो
> विनियुक्ताः । सूत्रितं च । कृणुष्ट पाजः प्रसितिं न पृथ्वीमिति पंच । आ. ४–६ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु—कृणुष्ट ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि नाल्कनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि हदिनैदु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋपियु ; रक्षोहाग्नियु देव
> तॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप् छंदस्सु अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—कृणुष्ट पंचोना राक्षोघ्नं ऎंदु हेळिरु
> वुदु. प्रातरनुवाक मत्तु आश्विनशस्त्रमंत्र पठनक्कागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदु. प्रवर्ग्य
> वॆंब यागदल्लियू कृणुष्ट पाजः ऎंदु मॊदलागुव ऐदु ऋक्कुगळ विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु
> आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—कृणुष्ट पाजः प्रसितिं न पृथ्वीमिति पंच ऎंब सूत्रदिंद
> (आ. ४–६) विवृतवागिरुवुदु.
> vjoh

> *kṛṇuṣveti paṃcadaśarcaṃ caturthaṃ sūktaṃ nāmadevasyārṣaṃ*
> *traiṣṭubhaṃ rakṣohāgni devatākaṃ | kṛṇuṣṭa paṃconā*
> *rākṣoghnamityanukramaṇikā ‖ prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayoḥ*
> *sūktaviniyogaḥ ‖ pravargye 'bhiṣṭave kṛṇuṣṭa pāja ityādyāḥ paṃcarco*
> *viniyuktāḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | kṛṇuṣṭa pājaḥ prasitiṃ na pṛthvīmiti paṃca |*
> *ā. 4-6 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—kṛṇuṣṭa èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèya anuvākadalli*
> *nālkanèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli hadinaidu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛpiyu ;*
> *rakṣohāgniyu deva*
> *tèyu ; triṣṭup chaṃdassu anukramaṇikèyalli—kṛṇuṣṭa paṃconā*
> *rākṣoghnaṃ èṃdu heḷiru*
> *vudu. prātaranuvāka mattu āśvinaśastramaṃtra paṭhanakkāgi ī sūktada*
> *viniyogaviruvudu. pravargya*
> *vèṃba yāgadalliyū kṛṇuṣṭa pājaḥ èṃdu mòdalāguva aidu ṛkkugaḷa*
> *viniyogaviruvudèṃdu*
> *āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—kṛṇuṣṭa pājaḥ prasitiṃ na pṛthvīmiti paṃca*
> *èṃba sūtradiṃda*
> *(ā. 4-6) vivṛtavāgiruvudu.*
> *vjoh*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta beginning कृणुष्व (*kṛṇuṣva*) is the fourth sūkta, of fifteen ṛks. Its seer is Vāmadeva, its deity Agni as Rakṣohā (slayer of Rakṣas), its metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā says: कृणुष्ट पंचोना राक्षोघ्नमित्यनुक्रमणिका (*kṛṇuṣṭa paṃconā rākṣoghnamityanukramaṇikā*). Viniyoga: the sūkta is used in the Prātaranuvāka and in the Āśvinaśastra. In the Pravargya, in the Abhiṣṭava, the five ṛks beginning कृणुष्ट पाजः (*kṛṇuṣṭa pājaḥ*) are employed; the sūtra says कृणुष्ट पाजः प्रसितिं न पृथ्वीमिति पंच (*kṛṇuṣṭa pājaḥ prasitiṃ na pṛthvīmiti paṃca*) (Ā. 4-6). The Kannada Anuvāda within the block says the same.

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Particulars

> सूक्त—४
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—४ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—४ ॥ वर्ग—२३, २४, २५ ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—१५ ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—अग्नी रक्षोहा ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *sūkta—4*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—4 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—4 ‖ varga—23, 24, 25 ‖*
> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—15 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agnī rakṣohā ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कृ॒णु॒ष्व पाज॒ः प्रसि॑ति॒ं न पृ॒थ्वीं या॒हि रा॒जेवाम॑वाँ॒ इभे॑न ।
तृ॒ष्वीमनु॒ प्रसि॑तिं द्रूणा॒नोऽस्ता॑सि॒ विध्य॑ र॒क्षस॒स्तपि॑ष्ठैः ॥ १ ॥

> *kṛṇuṣva pājaḥ prasitiṃ na pṛthvīṃ yāhi rājevāmavā~ ibhena |*
> *tṛṣvīmanu prasitiṃ drūṇāno 'stāsi vidhya rakṣasastapiṣṭhaiḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कृणुष्ट । पाजः । प्रसितिं । न । पृथ्वीं । याहि । राजाइव । अमवान् । इभेन ।
> तृष्टीं । अनु । प्रसितिं । द्रोणानः । अस्ता । असि । विध्य । रक्षसः । तपिष्ठैः ॥ १ ॥

> *kṛṇuṣṭa | pājaḥ | prasitiṃ | na | pṛthvīṃ | yāhi | rājāiva | amavān | ibhena |*
> *tṛṣṭīṃ | anu | prasitiṃ | droṇānaḥ | astā | asi | vidhya | rakṣasaḥ | tapiṣṭhaiḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने पाजस्तेजःसंघं कृणुष्ट । कुरुष्ट । विस्तारय । तत्र दृष्टांतः । प्रसितिं न । यथा मृगयुः पृथ्वीं विस्तीर्णां प्रसितिं । प्रकर्षण सीयते बध्यत इति प्रसितिर्वागुरा । तादृशीं प्रसितिं पक्षिग्रहणार्थं वनगहनेषु प्रसारयति तद्वत्त्वमपि रक्षांसि हंतुं महद्बलमग्रतस्तनुष्ट । इभेन गतभयेन तेजःसंघेन युक्तस्त्वं याहि । रक्षांसि हंतुं गच्छ । तत्र दृष्टांतः । राजेव । यथामवान् राजा । सह वर्तत इत्यमोऽमात्यः तद्वान् । यद्वा । अमोऽमनं रोगः । शत्रूणां कर्तवै रोगैस्तद्वान् । शत्रूणां रोगभूत इत्यर्थः । राजेभेन गजेन युक्तः सन् परबलं प्रतिगच्छति तद्वत् । किंच तृष्टीं । तृष्टीति क्षिप्रनाम । क्षिप्रगामिनीं प्रसितिं प्रकृष्णां सेनामनु द्रोणानोऽनुगच्छन् । यद्वा । तृष्टीमिति तृतीयार्थे द्वितीया । तृष्णा क्षिप्रया प्रसित्यानुबद्धया संततया गत्या द्रोणानः परसेनां हिंसन् अस्ता शत्रूणां क्षेप्तासि । तपिष्ठैस्तप्ततमैस्तजोभी रक्षसो राक्षसान्विद्य । ताडय ॥ अत्र निरुक्तं । कुरुष्ट पाजः । पाजः पालनात् । प्रसितिमिव पृथ्वीं । प्रसितिः प्रसहनात्तंतुर्वा जालं वा । याहि राजीनामात्यवानभ्यमनवा–

> *he agne pājastejaḥsaṃghaṃ kṛṇuṣṭa | kuruṣṭa | vistāraya | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | prasitiṃ na | yathā mṛgayuḥ pṛthvīṃ vistīrṇāṃ prasitiṃ | prakarṣaṇa sīyate badhyata iti prasitirvāgurā | tādṛśīṃ prasitiṃ pakṣigrahaṇārthaṃ vanagahaneṣu prasārayati tadvattvamapi rakṣāṃsi haṃtuṃ mahadbalamagratastanuṣṭa | ibhena gatabhayena tejaḥsaṃghena yuktastvaṃ yāhi | rakṣāṃsi haṃtuṃ gaccha | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | rājeva | yathāmavān rājā | saha vartata ityamo 'mātyaḥ tadvān | yadvā | amo 'manaṃ rogaḥ | śatrūṇāṃ kartavai rogaistadvān | śatrūṇāṃ rogabhūta ityarthaḥ | rājebhena gajena yuktaḥ san parabalaṃ pratigacchati tadvat | kiṃca tṛṣṭīṃ | tṛṣṭīti kṣipranāma | kṣipragāminīṃ prasitiṃ prakṛṣṇāṃ senāmanu droṇāno 'nugacchan | yadvā | tṛṣṭīmiti tṛtīyārthe dvitīyā | tṛṣṇā kṣiprayā prasityānubaddhayā saṃtatayā gatyā droṇānaḥ parasenāṃ hiṃsan astā śatrūṇāṃ kṣeptāsi | tapiṣṭhaistaptatamaistajobhī rakṣaso rākṣasānvidya | tāḍaya ‖ atra niruktaṃ | kuruṣṭa pājaḥ | pājaḥ pālanāt | prasitimiva pṛthvīṃ | prasitiḥ prasahanāttaṃturvā jālaṃ vā | yāhi rājīnāmātyavānabhyamanavā-*

> न्तस्त्ववान्वेरावता गणेन गतभयेन हस्तिनेति वा । तृष्णानु प्रसित्या द्रोणानः । तृष्टीति क्षिप्रनाम तरतेर्वा त्वरतेर्वा । अस्तासि विध्य रक्षसस्तपिष्ठैस्तप्ततमैस्तपिष्ठतमैरिति वा । नि. ६–१२ । इति ॥ कृणुष्ट । कृवि हिंसाकरणयोः । लोटि धिन्विकृण्वोर – च्छेत्युप्रत्ययः । व्यत्ययेनात्मनेपदं । विकरणस्वरस्तु सति शिष्टोऽपि लसार्वधातुक स्वरं न बाधत इति लसार्वधातुकस्वरः । म. ६–१–१५८–११ ॥

> *ntastvavānverāvatā gaṇena gatabhayena hastineti vā | tṛṣṇānu prasityā droṇānaḥ | tṛṣṭīti kṣipranāma taratervā tvaratervā | astāsi vidhya rakṣasastapiṣṭhaistaptatamaistapiṣṭhatamairiti vā | ni. 6-12 | iti ‖ kṛṇuṣṭa | kṛvi hiṃsākaraṇayoḥ | loṭi dhinvikṛṇvòra -*

> *cchetyupratyayaḥ | vyatyayenātmanepadaṃ | vikaraṇasvarastu sati śiṣṭo 'pi lasārvadhātuka*
> *svaraṃ na bādhata iti lasārvadhātukasvaraḥ | ma. 6-1-158-11 ||*

Summary

"O Agni, make (spread out) your mass of energy (pājas)." The illustration: as a hunter spreads a wide snare (prasiti) — prasiti is a net, that which is bound (sīyate) out and out — in thick forest to catch birds, so you too spread a great force in front to slay the Rakṣas. "Go (yāhi) to slay Rakṣas, accompanied by a mass of energy free from fear (ibhena)", like a king (amavān): amaḥ is a minister (āmātya), one who is with him; or else amaḥ is illness (amana), the king who is a disease to his enemies; or the king goes against the enemy's army on an elephant (ibha). Further, tṛṣṭī is a word for "swift": following (dronānaḥ) the swift-going prasiti, the superior army. Or else tṛṣṭīm stands in the accusative for the instrumental: going on with the swift, continuous course attached to the host, you, harming the enemy army, are the hurler (astā) of foes. With your hottest (tapiṣṭha) flames pierce (vidhya), strike, the Rakṣas. Here the Nirukta: कुरुष्ट पाजः । पाजः पालनात् । प्रसितिमिव पृथ्वीं । प्रसितिः प्रसहनात्तंतुर्वा जालं वा । याहि राजीनामात्यवानभ्यमनवा- (*kuruṣṭa pājaḥ | pājaḥ pālanāt | prasitimiva pṛthvīṃ | prasitiḥ prasahanāttaṃturvā jālaṃ vā | yāhi rājīnāmātyavānabhyamanavā-*) (continued in the next block).

The Nirukta continues: with a troop that has lost fear, or with an elephant; tṛṣṭī is a word for swift, from tarati or tvarate; "you are the hurler, pierce the Rakṣas with the hottest", tapiṣṭha being explained as tapta-tama or tapiṣṭha-tama (Ni. 6-12). The rest of the block is grammar of kṛṇuṣva and is left to the Grammar.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- पृथ्विं (*pṛthviṃ*)—wide
- प्रसितं न (*prasitaṃ na*)—as (a hunter) spreads a net
- पाजः (*pājaḥ*)—your mass of energy
- कृणुष्व (*kṛṇuṣṭva*)—spread out
- इभीन (*ibhīna*)—mounted on an elephant

- अमवान् (*amavān*)—with his retinue
- इव (*iva*)—like a king setting out on a campaign
- इभेन (*ibhena*)—together with your energies
- याहि (*yāhi*)—set out to destroy the enemy
- प्रसितिं (*prasitiṃ*)—the excellent army
- अनु द्रोणानः (*anu droṇānaḥ*)—following
- अस्ता असि (*astā asi*)—you are the scatterer of foes
- तपिष्ठैः (*tapiṣṭhaiḥ*)—with scorching energies
- रक्षसः (*rakṣasaḥ*)—the Rākṣasas
- विध्य (*vidhya*)—beat down

Gist

O Agni, spread out your mass of energy as a hunter casts and spreads a wide net. As a king mounted on an elephant and accompanied by his retinue sets out on a campaign, so set out with your energies to destroy the enemy. Following the excellent army, you are the scatterer of foes. With scorching energies beat down the Rākṣasas.

English translation

Put forth your strength, Agni, as a fowler spreads a capacious snare : proceed like a king attended by his followers on his elephant : you are the scatterer (of your foes) ; following the swift-moving host consume the Rakshasas with your fierce flames

Special Topics

Amavān—In stating the derivation of this word, Yāska has given an explanation of this ṛk कृणुस्व पाजः (*kṛṇusva pājaḥ*): कुरुष्व पाजः । पाजः पालनात् । प्रसितिमिव पृथ्वीं । प्रसितिः प्रसयनात् तंतुर्वा जालं ना! याहि राजीनामात्यवानभ्यमनवान् स्ववान्वेराभृता गणेन गतभयेन हस्तिनेति वा । तृष्णानु प्रसित्या द्रोणाननः । तृष्णिति क्षिप्रनाम तरतेर्वा त्वरतेर्वा । असितासि विध्यरक्षसस्तपिष्ठैस्तप्ततम्मस्तप्ततम्मैः प्रपिष्टतम्मैरिति वा । (*kuruṣva pājaḥ | pājaḥ pālanāt | prasitimiva pṛthvīṃ | prasitiḥ prasayanāt taṃturvā jālaṃ nā! yāhi rājīnāmātyavānabhyamanavān svavānverābhṛtā gaṇena gatabhayena hastineti vā | tṛṣṇānu prasityā droṇānanaḥ | tṛṣṇiti* *kṣipranāma taratervā tvaratervā | asitāsi vidhyarakṣasastapiṣṭhaistaptatammastaptatammaiḥ prapiṣṭatammairiti vā* |) (नि (*ni*). ६ १ (*6 1*):)[?387]

O Agni, spread out your strength. The word pājaḥ indicates the meaning "protection". The word prasiti, formed from the root pra+si, gives the meaning "bind, tie"; therefore prasiti means a cord or a net. Here Agni is addressed: go like a king. The manner of a king's going is described thus: like a king with his amātya (minister), or going terrible to his enemies, or going together with his followers, or going seated on a fearless elephant — so Agni is praised: go like that. Tṛṣṭi means "quickly"; this word may be formed from the root tarati or from tvarati. O Agni, strike the Rākṣasas with arrows, harm them, and pierce, pulverise and destroy them with burning or blazing sharp spears (śalya): so Agni is praised.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तव॑ भ्र॒मास॑ आशु॒या प॑त॒न्त्यनु॑ स्पृश धृ॒षता शोशु॑चा
नः ।
तपूं॑ष्यग्ने जु॒ह्वा॑ पत॒ंगानसं॑दितो॒ वि सृं॑ज॒ विष्वं॑गु॒ल्काः
॥ २ ॥

> *tava bhramāsa āśuyā patantyanu spṛśa dhṛṣatā śośucānaḥ |*
> *tapūṃṣyagne juhvā pataṃgānasaṃdito vi sṛja viṣvagulkāḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तस । भ्रमासः । आतुया । पतंति । असु । स्पृश । धृषता । शोशुचानः ।
> तपूंषि । अग्ने । जुह्वा । पतंगान् । असंदितः । वि । सृज । विष्वक् । उल्काः ॥ २ ॥

> *tasa | bhramāsaḥ | ātuyā | pataṃti | asu | spṛśa | dhṛṣatā | śośucānaḥ |*
> *tapūṃṣi | agne | juhvā | pataṃgān | asaṃditaḥ | vi | sṛja | viṣvak | ulkāḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने तव संबंधिनो भमासो भ्राम्यंत आशुया शीघ्रगतयो रश्मयः
> पतंति । सर्वतः प्रसरंति । शोशुचानो भृशं दीप्यमानस्त्वं धृषताभिभवसमर्थेन
> तेजःसंघेन शत्रूननु क्रमेण स्पृश । दह । दहनोपायं दर्शयति । असंदितः
> परैरनिरुद्धस्त्वं तपूंषि तापकानि तेजांसि पतंगान् पतनशीलान्विस्सुलिंगानुल्याश्चेत्येतत्त्रितयं
> जुह्वा । हूयंतेऽस्यामाहुतय इति जुहूर्च्चाला । तया निष्वक्
> सर्वतो वि सृज । प्रसारय ॥ आशुया । आशुशब्दाज्ञसः सुपां सुलुगिति याजादेशः।
> चित्स्वरः । धृषता । धृष प्रसहने । चुरादिराधृषीयः । व्यत्ययेनशः । शतुरनुम
> इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं । जुह्वा । जुहोतीदीर्घश्चेति क्विप् द्विर्वचनं दीर्घत्वं ।
> उदात्तयणो हल्पूर्वादिति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वस्य नोञ्धात्वोरिति प्रतिषेध उदात्त–

> *he agne tava saṃbaṃdhino bhamāso bhrāmyaṃta āśuyā śīghragatayo raśmayaḥ*
> *pataṃti | sarvataḥ prasaraṃti | śośucāno bhṛśaṃ dīpyamānastvaṃ dhṛṣatābhibhavasamarthena*
> *tejaḥsaṃghena śatrūnanu krameṇa spṛśa | daha | dahanopāyaṃ darśayati | asaṃditaḥ*
> *parairaniruddhastvaṃ tapūṃṣi tāpakāni tejāṃsi pataṃgān patanaśīlānvissuliṃgānulyāścetyetattritayaṃ juhvā | hūyaṃte 'syāmāhutaya iti juhūrccālā | tayā niṣvak*
> *sarvato vi sṛja | prasāraya ‖ āśuyā | āśuśabdājjasaḥ supāṃ sulugiti yājādeśaḥ|*
> *citsvaraḥ | dhṛṣatā | dhṛṣa prasahane | curādirādhṛṣīyaḥ | vyatyayenaśaḥ | śaturanuma*
> *iti vibhakterudāttatvaṃ | juhvā | juhotīdīrghaśceti kvip dvirvacanaṃ dīrghatvaṃ |*
> *udāttayaṇo halpūrvāditi vibhakterudāttatvasya noñdhātvoriti pratiṣedha udātta-*

> स्वरितयोर्यण इति स्वरितत्वं । असंदितः । दो अवखंडने । कर्मणि निष्ठा । द्यतिस्यतीतीत्वं । नञ्ञा समासे तस्य स्वरः ॥

> *svaritayoryaṇa iti svaritatvaṃ | asaṃditaḥ | do avakhaṃḍane | karmaṇi niṣṭhā | dyatisyatītītvaṃ | nañjā samāse tasya svaraḥ ||*

Summary

"O Agni, your wandering (bhramāsaḥ), swift-going rays fall (patanti), spread everywhere. Blazing (śośucānaḥ) intensely, touch (spṛśa) the enemies in order, burn them, with your mass of energy that can overpower (dhṛṣatā)." He shows the means of burning: unhindered (asandita) by others, scatter everywhere (viṣvak, vi sṛja) with the juhū, that is the flame, in which oblations are offered, your scorching energies (tapūṃṣi), the flying sparks (patangān) and the brands (ulkāḥ) — these three. The rest of the block is grammar (āśuyā, dhṛṣatā, juhvā, asandita) and continues on the next page.

The block gives only grammatical derivations (asandita, from the root dā, avakhaṇḍane, with the negative compound and its accent).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- तव (*tava*)—your
- भ्रमासः (*bhramāsaḥ*)—wandering
- आशुया (*āśuyā*)—swift-moving rays
- पतंति (*pataṃti*)—spread everywhere
- शोशुचानः (*śośucānaḥ*)—you, brightly shining
- धृषता (*dhṛṣatā*)—with the energy that checks enemies
- अनु (*anu*)—in order
- स्पृश (*spṛśa*)—burn (the enemies)
- असंदितः (*asaṃditaḥ*)—you, not stopped by enemies
- तपूंषि (*tapūṃṣi*)—burning energies
- पतंगान् (*pataṃgān*)—sparks
- उल्काः (*ulkāḥ*)—brands
- जुह्वा (*juhvā*)—with your flame
- विस्वक् (*visvak*)—everywhere
- वि सृज (*vi sṛja*)—spread out

Gist

O Agni, your wandering, swift-moving rays spread everywhere. Brightly shining, burn the enemies in order with the energy that checks enemies. Unhindered by enemies, spread everywhere with your flame your burning energies, sparks and brands.

English translation

your swift and errant flames descend (on every side) ; fierce-shining with vigour consume (the foe) ; scatter, Agni, with the ladle (of oblation), scorching flames, and sparks, and brands.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्रति॒ स्पशो॒ वि सृ॑ज॒ तूर्णि॑तमो॒ भवा॑ पा॒युर्वि॒शो अ॒
स्या अद॑ब्धः ।
यो नो॑ दू॒रे अ॒घशं॑सो॒ यो अन्त्यग्ने॒ माकि॑ष्टे॒ व्यथि॒
रा द॑धर्षीत् ॥ ३ ॥

> *prati spaśo vi sṛja tūrṇitamo bhavā pāyurviśo asyā adabdhaḥ |*
> *yo no dūre aghaśaṃso yo antyagne mākiṣṭe vyathirā dadharṣīt ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्रति । स्पशः । वि । सृज । तूर्णेतमः । भव । पायुः । विशः । अस्याः । अदब्धः ।
> यः । नः । दूरे । अघशंसः । यः । अंति । अग्ने । माकिः । ते । व्यथिः । आ ।
> दधर्षीत् ॥ ३ ॥

> *prati | spaśaḥ | vi | sṛja | tūrṇetamaḥ | bhava | pāyuḥ | viśaḥ | asyāḥ | adabdhaḥ |*
> *yaḥ | naḥ | dūre | aghaśaṃsaḥ | yaḥ | aṃti | agne | mākiḥ | te | vyathiḥ | ā |*
> *dadharṣīt ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने तूर्णितमस्त्वरिततमस्त्वं स्पशः परबाधकान्रश्मिन् चारान्वा सत्यानृतविवेकार्थं वि सृज । शत्रून्प्रति विशेषेण प्रेरय । अदब्धः केनाप्यहिंसितस्त्वमस्यास्त्वदीयाया
> विशोऽस्मदादिकायाः प्रजायाः पायु: पालको भव । कस्मात्तद्रक्षण.
> मित्यपेक्षायामाह । नोऽस्माकं दूरे योऽघशंसः । अघं पापात्मकं शंसनमभिलाषः कीर्तनं ना
> यस्य सोऽघशंसः । यश्चाघशंसोऽ०त्यस्माकं समीपे तिष्ठति
> शस्मादुभयविधाच्छत्रोः पालको भव । किंच ते त्वत्संबंधिनोऽस्मान्माकिर्न
> कश्चिदपि व्यथिर्बाधको राक्षस आ दधर्षीत् । आधर्षयतु । आस्माकं कश्चिदपि
> परिभवं मा करोत्वित्यर्थः ॥ अंति । अंतिकस्य कादिलोप आद्युदात्तत्वं च । अग्ने ।
> षादादित्वात्पाष्ठिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं । माकिष्ट इति संहितायां युष्मत्तत्ततक्षुःष्टंतः
> पादमिति षत्वं । दधर्षीत् । धृष प्रसहने । लजु बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः ।
> बहुलं छंदसीति तिप ईडागमः । निघातः ॥

> *he agne tūrṇitamastvaritatamastvaṃ spaśaḥ parabādhakānraśmin cārānvā satyānṛtavivekārthaṃ vi sṛja | śatrūnprati viśeṣeṇa preraya | adabdhaḥ kenāpyahiṃsitastvamasyāstvadīyāyā viśo 'smadādikāyāḥ prajāyāḥ pāyu: pālako bhava | kasmāttadrakṣaṇa.*
> *mityapekṣāyāmāha | no 'smākaṃ dūre yo 'ghaśaṃsaḥ | agham pāpātmakaṃ śaṃsanamabhilāṣaḥ kīrtanaṃ nā yasya so 'ghaśaṃsaḥ |*
> *yaścāghaśaṃso 'otyasmākaṃ samīpe tiṣṭhati*
> *śasmādubhayavidhācchatroḥ pālako bhava | kiṃca te tvatsaṃbaṃdhino 'smānmākirna*
> *kaścidapi vyathirbādhako rākṣasa ā dadharṣīt | ādharṣayatu | āsmākaṃ kaścidapi*
> *paribhavaṃ mā karotvityarthaḥ ‖ aṃti | aṃtikasya kādilopa ādyudāttatvaṃ ca | agne |*
> *ṣādāditvātpāṣṭhikamādyudāttatvaṃ | mākiṣṭa iti saṃhitāyāṃ yuṣmattattatakṣuḥṣṭaṃtaḥ*
> *pādamiti ṣatvaṃ | dadharṣīt | dhṛṣa prasahane | laju bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti tipa īḍāgamaḥ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, swiftest (tūrṇitama), send forth (vi sṛja) your stinging (spaśaḥ) rays — or spies, for the discernment of truth and falsehood — send them forth especially against the enemies. Unharmed (adabdha) by anyone, be the protector (pāyuḥ) of this your people (viś), that is, of us and others." If it is asked from what protection is needed, he says: whoever is far from us as an aghaśaṃsa — one whose utterance (śaṃsana), wish or praise, is aghaṃ, sinful — and whoever stands near us: be the protector against both kinds of enemy. "And let no one, no harassing (vyathi) Rākṣasa, assail (ā dadharṣīt) us who are yours": that is, let no one at all overcome us. The rest of the block is grammar (anti, agne, mākiṣṭe, dadharṣīt).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- तूर्णितमः (*tūrṇitamaḥ*)—you, of swift motion
- स्पशः (*spaśaḥ*)—your rays that harm the enemies
- प्रति वि सृज (*prati vi sṛja*)—spread and send forth
- अदब्धः (*adabdhaḥ*)—you, harmed by none
- अस्याः (*asyāḥ*)—belonging to you
- विशः (*viśaḥ*)—to us, your people
- पायुः (*pāyuḥ*)—as protector
- भव (*bhava*)—be
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- दूरे (*dūre*)—far away
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which
- अघशंसः (*aghaśaṃsaḥ*)—sinner
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which sin-wisher
- अंति (*aṃti*)—is near (protect us from all of them)
- ते (*te*)—us who belong to you
- माकिः (*mākiḥ*)—no one at all
- व्यथिः (*vyathiḥ*)—as a harasser
- आ दधर्षीत् (*ā dadharṣīt*)—let him not fall upon (us)

Gist

O Agni, of swift motion, spread your rays that harm the enemies. Unharmed by anyone, protect us, your people, from all sinners, whether far or near. Let no one fall upon us who belong to you and harm us.

English translation

You, who are most rapid, direct your (flames) against opposing (rays), and, unresisted, become the protector of this your people against the calumiator who is remote or who is nigh : let no malevolent (foe) prevail against us (who are) your worshippers.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उद॑ग्ने तिष्ठ॒ प्रत्या त॑नुष्व॒ न्य१॒॑मित्राँ॑ ओषतात्तिग्महेते ।
यो नो॒ अरा॑तिं समिधान च॒क्रे नी॒चा तं ध॑क्ष्यत॒सं न शुष्क॑म् ॥ ४ ॥

> *udagne tiṣṭha pratyā tanuṣva nyamitrā~ oṣatāttigmahete |*
> *yo no arātiṃ samidhāna cakre nīcā taṃ dhakṣyatasaṃ na śuṣkam ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उत् । अग्ने । तिष्ठ । प्रति । आ । तनुष्ट । नि । अमित्रान् । ओषतात् । तिग्महेते ।
> यः । नः । अरातिं । सम्ऽइधान । चक्रे । नीचा । तम् । धक्षि । अतसं । न । शुष्कं ॥

> *ut | agne | tiṣṭha | prati | ā | tanuṣṭa | ni | amitrān | oṣatāt | tigmahete |*
> *yaḥ | naḥ | arātiṃ | sam 'idhāna | cakre | nīcā | tam | dhakṣi | atasaṃ | na | śuṣkaṃ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> तिग्महेते । तिग्मास्तीक्ष्णा हे तयो ज्वाला यस्य स तथोक्तः । तादृश हे अग्ने
> उत्तिष्ठ । रक्षोहननार्थमुद्यतो भव । शत्रून्प्रत्या तनुष्ट । ज्वालासंघं विस्तारय ।
> तैस्तेजःसंघैरमित्रान् शत्रून्नोषतात् । नितरां दह । हे समिधान समिद्भिर्दिप्यमानाग्ने यः पुमान्
> नोऽस्माकमरातिं । भावप्रधाननिर्देशः । अरातित्वं ।
> शात्रवं चक्रे । कुरुते । अरातिमदानं वा कुरुते । तं पुमांसं नीचा न्यग्भूतं
> धक्षि । दह । तत्र दृष्टांतः . अतसं न। यथा शुष्कमनाद्रमतसं काष्ठं दहसि तद्वत्॥

> ओषतात् । उष दाहे । लोटि हेस्तहोरिति तातजादेशः । धक्षि । दहेर्लोटि
> बहुलं छंदसीति शपो लुक् । हो ढ इति ढत्वं । भष्भावः । षडोः कः सीति कत्वं ।
> निघातः ॥

> *tigmahete | tigmāstīkṣṇā hè tayo jvālā yasya sa tathoktaḥ | tādṛśa he agne*
> *uttiṣṭha | rakṣohananārthamudyato bhava | śatrūnpratyā tanuṣṭa |*
> *jvālāsaṃghaṃ vistāraya | taistejaḥsaṃghairamitrān śatrūnnoṣatāt |*
> *nitarāṃ daha | he samidhāna samidbhirdiṣyamānāgne yaḥ pumān no*
> *'smākamarātiṃ | bhāvapradhānanirdeśaḥ | arātitvaṃ |*
> *śātravaṃ cakre | kurute | arātimadānaṃ vā kurute | taṃ pumāṃsaṃ nīcā nyagbhūtaṃ*
> *dhakṣi | daha | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ . atasaṃ na| yathā*
> *śuṣkamanādrramatasaṃ kāṣṭhaṃ dahasi tadvat‖*
> *oṣatāt | uṣa dāhe | loṭi hestahoriti tātajādeśaḥ | dhakṣi | daherloṭi*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapo luk | ho ḍha iti ḍhatvaṃ | bhaṣbhāvaḥ | ṣaḍoḥ kaḥ sīti katvaṃ |*
> *nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

Tigmahete: one whose flames (*hètayaḥ*) are sharp. Such an Agni is told to rise, that is, to be ready to slay the Rākṣasas, and to spread the mass of his flames against the enemies. With those masses of fire he is to burn the foes (अमित्रान् (*amitrān*)) completely. "O Samidhāna" means Agni kindled with fuel-sticks. Whatever man makes arāti (enmity) towards us — arāti is stated as an abstract notion, meaning enmity (शात्रवं (*śātravaṃ*)) — or, as the text has it, produces arāti-intoxication (अरातिमदानं (*arātimadānaṃ*)), him Agni is to burn, cast down, as one burns a dry, moistureless piece of timber (अतसं (*atasaṃ*)).[?388]

Word-to-word meaning

- तिग्महेते (*tigmahete*)—having sharp flames
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- उत्तिष्ठ (*uttiṣṭha*)—rise, for the slaying of foes
- पत्या (*patyā*)—your mass of flames[?389]

- आ तनुष्प (*ā tanuṣpa*)—spread out
- अमित्रान् (*amitrān*)—the enemies
- नि ओषतात् (*ni oṣatāt*)—burn completely
- समिधान (*samidhāna*)—O Agni, who blaze up with fuel-sticks
- यः (*yaḥ*)—whatever man
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- आरातिं (*ārātiṃ*)—enmity
- चक्रे (*cakre*)—fosters
- तं (*taṃ*)—him
- नीचा (*nīcā*)—thrusting down
- शुक्रं(*śukraṃ*)—dry[?390]
- आतसं न (*ātasaṃ na*)—as one burns timber
- धक्षि (*dhakṣi*)—burn

Gist

O Agni, of sharp flames, make yourself ready for slaying the foes. Spread out the mass of your flames. Burn the enemies completely. O Agni, who blaze up with fuel-sticks, burn the man who fosters enmity towards us.

English translation

Sharp-weaponed Agni, rise up ; spread wide (your flames)against (the Rakshasas) ; entirely consume the foes ; blazing Agni,burn down him who acts as an enemy towards us like a piece of dry timber.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऊ॒र्ध्वो भ॑व॒ प्रति॑ वि॒ध्याध्य॒स्मदा॒विष्कृ॑णुष्व॒ दैव्या॑न्य
ग्ने ।
अव॑ स्थि॒रा त॑नुहि यातु॒जूनां॑ जा॒मिमजा॑मिं॒ प्र मृ॑णी
हि॒ शत्रू॑न् ॥ ५ ॥

> *ūrdhvo bhava prati vidhyādhyasmadāviṣkṛṇuṣva daivyānyagne |*
> *ava sthirā tanuhi yātujūnāṃ jāmimajāmiṃ pra mṛṇīhi śatrūn ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऊर्ध्वः । भव । प्रति । विध्य । अधि । अस्मत् । आविः । कृणुष्ट । दैव्यानि । अग्ने ।
> अव । स्थिरा । तनुहि । यातुजूनां । जामिं । अजामिं । प्र । मृणीहि । शत्रून् ॥

> *ūrdhvaḥ | bhava | prati | vidhya | adhi | asmat | āviḥ | kṛṇuṣṭa | daivyāni | agne |*
> *ava | sthirā | tanuhi | yātujūnāṃ | jāmiṃ | ajāmiṃ | pra | mṛṇīhi | śatrūn ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ऊर्ध्वो भव । रक्षोहननार्थमुद्युक्तो भव । अस्मदस्मत्तोऽधि
> अधिकानाक्षसान् प्रति विध्य । प्रत्येकं ताडय । दैव्यानि तेजांसि चाविष्कृणुष्ट ।
> अविष्कुरु । एतत्रयं विधाय यातुजूनां यातयितुं प्राणिनः क्लेशयितुं ये
> जनं कुर्वंति तेषां यातुधानानां स्थिरा दृढानि धनूंष्यव तनुहि । अवगतज्यानि

> *he agne ūrdhvo bhava | rakṣohananārthamudyukto bhava | asmadasmatto 'dhi*
> *adhikānākṣasān prati vidhya | pratyekaṃ tāḍaya | daivyāni tejāṃsi cāviṣkṛṇuṣṭa |*
> *aviṣkuru | etatrayaṃ vidhāya yātujūnāṃ yātayituṃ prāṇinaḥ kleśayituṃ ye*
> *janaṃ kurvaṃti teṣāṃ yātudhānānāṃ sthirā dṛḍhāni dhanūṃṣyava tanuhi | avagatajyāni*

> कुरु । किंच जामिमजामिं बंधुमबंधुं शत्रून् मृणीहि । प्रजहि । यद्वा ।
> जामिं यः पूर्वं प्रहृतस्तं । अजामिं पूर्वमप्रहृतं । एवंभूतान् शत्रून्
> जहि । प्रहृतोऽयमित्यपेक्षां मा कृथाः ॥ आविष्कृणुष्टेत्यत्र संहितायामिदुदुपधस्य
> चाप्रत्ययस्येति षत्वं । तनुहि । तनोतेर्लोट्युतश्च प्रत्ययाच्छंदसि वावचनमिति हेर्लुगभावः ।
> यातुजूनां । जु गत् । क्विब्बचीत्यादिना क्विप् । दीर्घः । आमि
> छांदसो नुम् । मृणीहि । मृज् प्राणत्यागे । अंतर्भावितण्यर्थस्य लोटि बहुलं
> छंदसीति विकरणस्य श्ना । निघातः ॥

> *kuru | kiṃca jāmimajāmiṃ baṃdhumabaṃdhuṃ śatrūn mṛṇīhi | prajahi | yadvā |*
> *jāmiṃ yaḥ pūrvaṃ prahṛtastaṃ | ajāmiṃ pūrvamaprahṛtaṃ |*

> *evaṃbhūtān śatrūn*
> *jahi | prahṛto 'yamityapekṣāṃ mā kṛthāḥ ‖ āviṣkṛṇuṣṭetyatra*
> *saṃhitāyāmidudupadhasya cāpratyayasyeti ṣatvaṃ | tanuhi |*
> *tanoterloṭyutaśca pratyayācchaṃdasi vāvacanamiti herlugabhāvaḥ |*
> *yātujūnāṃ | ju gat | kvibbacītyādinā kvip | dīrghaḥ | āmi*
> *chāṃdaso num | mṛṇīhi | mṛj prāṇatyāge | aṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthasya loṭi bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya śnā | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, be upright, that is, be ready for slaying the Rākṣasas. Pierce each one separately of the Rākṣasas who are more numerous than we are (*asmadadhi*). Make manifest your divine energies. Having done these three things, unstring the strong bows of the Yātujūs, those Yātudhānas who work to torment living beings; make them bowstring-less.

Further, destroy the enemies, whether kindred or non-kindred (जामिमजामिं (*jāmimajāmiṃ*)). Or else: jāmi is one who has been struck before, ajāmi one not struck before; slay enemies of both sorts, and do not hesitate with the thought "this one has already been struck."

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ऊर्ध्वो भव (*ūrdhvo bhava*)—rise up and stand, for victory over the foes
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—than we
- अधि (*adhi*)—the foes who are greater in number
- प्रति विध्य (*prati vidhya*)—beat down one by one
- दैव्यानि (*daivyāni*)—your divine energies
- आविष्कृणुष्व्वा (*āviṣkṛṇuṣṭvā*)—make manifest
- यातुजूनां (*yātujūnāṃ*)—of the Rākṣasas
- स्थिरा (*sthirā*)—the strong bows
- अव तनुहि (*ava tanuhi*)—make them without bowstring (jyā)
- जामिं (*jāmiṃ*)—be he a kinsman
- अजामिं (*ajāmiṃ*)—or not a kinsman
- शत्रून् (*śatrūn*)—those who wish us harm

- मृणीहि (*mṛṇīhi*)—conquer and subdue

Gist

O Agni, be ready for victory over the foes. Destroy one by one the foes who are more numerous than we. Make your divine energies manifest. Tear off the strings of the strong bows of the Rākṣasas. Whether they are our kinsmen or not, conquer and subdue those who wish us harm.

English translation

Rise up, Agni chastise those who overpower us ; manifest your divine energies; slacken the strong (bow strings) of the malignant kings ; destroy those (who are hostile), whether kindred or unallied.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स ते॑ जानाति सुम॒तिं य॑विष्ठ॒ य ईव॑ते॒ ब्रह्म॑णे गा॒तुमैर॑त् ।
विश्वा॑न्यस्मै सु॒दिना॑नि रा॒यो द्यु॒म्नान्य॒र्यो वि दुरो॑ अ॒भि द्यौ॑त् ॥ ६ ॥

> *sa te jānāti sumatiṃ yaviṣṭha ya īvate brahmaṇe gātumairat |*
> *viśvānyasmai sudināni rāyo dyumnānyaryo vi duro abhi dyaut ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । ते । जानाति । सुमतिं । यविष्ठ । यः । ईवते । ब्रह्मणे । गातुं । ऐरत् ।
> विश्वानि । अस्मै । सुदिनानि । रायः । द्युम्नानि । अर्यः । वि । दुरः । अभि । द्यौत् ॥

> *saḥ | te | jānāti | sumatiṃ | yaviṣṭha | yaḥ | īvate | brahmaṇe | gātuṃ | airat |*
> *viśvāni | asmai | sudināni | rāyaḥ | dyumnāni | aryaḥ | vi | duraḥ | abhi | dyaut ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यविष्ठ युवतम । यद्वा । देवानां हवींषि मिश्रयित्यृतम हे अग्ने यः
> पुमानीवते गमनवते कल्याणहेतुभूतागमनाय ब्रह्मणे परिवृढाय तुभ्यं
> गातुं । गीयत उच्चार्यत इति गातुः स्तोत्रं । तदैरत् । प्रेरयति । स पुमान्
> ते तव सुमतिं कल्याणकरीमनुग्रहात्मिकां बुद्धिं जानाति । लभत इत्यर्थः । अस्मै
> स्तोत्रं कृतवते यजमानाय तदर्थ० विश्वानि सुदिनानि शोभनानि दिनानि रायो
> धनानि द्युम्नानि द्युतिमंति रत्नकनकादीनि दुरो गृहानभि अभिलक्ष्यार्यो यज्ञानां स्वामी त्वं
> वि द्यौत् । विशेषेण द्योतस्व । केचिदत्र वाक्यभेदमंगीकुर्वते ।
> स्तोत्रं कृतवते यजमानाय विश्वानि सुदिनान्यभ्युदयकारीणि भवंति । रायः ।
> रांति क्षीरादीनीति रायो गोधनानि । द्युम्नानि द्योतमानानि कनकादीनि चास्मे
> भवंति। अर्यः कर्मणामनुष्ठाता स यजमानो दुरो गृहानभिवि द्यौत् । विशेषेण द्योतते ॥ ईवते ।
> ई गत् । क्विप् । तदस्यास्तीति मतुप् । छंदसीर इति
> मतुपो वत्वं । ऐरत् । ईर गत् । यद्वृत्तयोगादनिघातः । अर्यः । ऋ गत् ।
> अर्यः स्वामिवैश्ययोरिति यत्पत्ययांतो निपातितः । स्वामिन्यंतोदात्तत्वं ।
> द्यौत् । द्युत दीप्तौ । छांदसे लुजु द्युद्भ्यो लुजीति परस्पॆपदं । बहुलु
> छंदसीत्यडभावः ॥

> *yaviṣṭha yuvatama | yadvā | devānāṃ havīṃṣi miśrayityṛtama he agne yaḥ*
> *pumānīvate gamanavate kalyāṇahetubhūtāgamanāya brahmaṇe parivṛḍhāya tubhyaṃ*
> *gātuṃ | gīyata uccāryata iti gātuḥ stotraṃ | tadairat | prerayati | sa pumān*
> *te tava sumatiṃ kalyāṇakarīmanugrahātmikāṃ buddhiṃ jānāti | labhata ityarthaḥ | asmai*
> *stotraṃ kṛtavate yajamānāya tadarthao viśvāni sudināni śobhanāni dināni rāyo*
> *dhanāni dyumnāni dyutimaṃti ratnakanakādīni duro gṛhānabhi abhilakṣyāryo yajñānāṃ svāmī tvaṃ vi dyaut | viśeṣeṇa dyotasva | kecidatra vākyabhedamaṃgīkurvate |*
> *stotraṃ kṛtavate yajamānāya viśvāni sudinānyabhyudayakārīṇi bhavaṃti | rāyaḥ |*
> *rāṃti kṣīrādīnīti rāyo godhanāni | dyumnāni dyotamānāni kanakādīni cāsme*
> *bhavaṃti| aryaḥ karmaṇāmanuṣṭhātā sa yajamāno duro gṛhānabhivi dyaut | viśeṣeṇa dyotate ‖ īvate | ī gat | kvip | tadasyāstīti matup |*

> *chaṃdasīra iti*
> *matupo vatvaṃ | airat | īra gat | yadvṛttayogādanighātaḥ | aryaḥ | ṛ gat |*
> *aryaḥ svāmivaiśyayoriti yatpatyayāṃto nipātitaḥ |*
> *svāminyaṃtodāttatvaṃ |*
> *dyaut | dyuta dīptau | chāṃdase luju dyudbho lujīti paraspèpadaṃ | bahulu*
> *chaṃdasītyaḍabhāvaḥ ||*

Summary

Yaviṣṭha: youngest; or else, the best mixer of the oblations of the gods. O Agni, the man who sends forth a hymn (गातुं (*gātuṃ*), that which is sung or uttered, a stotra) to you, who are ईवते (*īvate*), one who goes and comes for the sake of bringing welfare, and ब्रह्मणे (*brahmaṇe*), great — that man obtains (जानाति (*jānāti*), "gains") your sumati, your favourable and gracious mind. For this yajamāna who has made the praise, you, as arya, lord of the sacrifices, shine forth specially, looking towards his houses (दुरः (*duraḥ*)), upon all fair days, riches (रायः (*rāyaḥ*)) and brilliant treasures (द्युम्नानि (*dyumnāni*)) such as jewels and gold. Some accept here a division of the sentence: for the yajamāna who has made the praise all fair days become prosperous; rāyaḥ are cattle-wealth, so called because they give milk and the like; shining things such as gold become his; and arya, the performer of the rites, that yajamāna, shines specially in his houses.

Word-to-word meaning

- यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)—O youthful Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- ईवते (*īvate*)—to you, who come to the sacrifice
- ब्रह्मणे (*brahmaṇe*)—and are Brahman in essence, addressing you
- गातु (*gātu*)—the hymn
- ऐरत् (*airat*)—recites
- सः (*saḥ*)—he
- ते (*te*)—your
- सुमतिं (*sumatiṃ*)—gracious mind
- जानाति (*jānāti*)—obtains

- अस्मै (*asmai*)—for such a yajamāna
- विश्वानि (*viśvāni*)—all
- सुदिनानि (*sudināni*)—pleasant days
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—riches
- द्युम्नानि (*dyumnāni*)—treasures such as jewels
- दुरः अभि (*duraḥ abhi*)—in his house
- अरः (*araḥ*)—you, the lord
- विद्यौत् (*vidyaut*)—cause to shine

Gist

O youthful Agni, the man who recites a hymn addressed to you, who come to the sacrifice and are Brahman in essence, obtains your gracious mind. For such a yajamāna, you, the lord, are to make all wealth, gold and other riches shine in his house.

English translation

He experiences your good favour, youngest (of the gods), who offers praise to you, a Brahman, coming quickly (to bestow felicity) ; to him are all prosperous days and wealth (of cattle) and treasures ; you, as the lord of sacrifice, shine upon his dewelling.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सेद॑ग्ने अस्तु सु॒भग॑ः सु॒दानु॒र्यस्त्वा॒ नित्ये॑न ह॒विषा॒ य उ॒क्थैः ।
पिप्री॑षति॒ स्व आयु॑षि दुरो॒णे विश्वेद॑स्मै सु॒दिना॒ सास॑दि॒ष्टिः ॥ ७ ॥

> *sedagne astu subhagaḥ sudānuryastvā nityena haviṣā ya ukthaiḥ |*
> *piprīṣati sva āyuṣi duroṇe viśvedasmai sudinā sāsadiṣṭiḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । इत् । अग्ने । अस्तु । सुभगः । सुदानुः । यः । त्वा । नित्येन । हविषा । यः ।
> उक्षैः ।
> पिप्रीषति । स्वे । आयुषि । दुरोणे । विश्वा । इत् । अस्मै । सुदिना । सा । असत् ।
> इष्टिः ॥ ७ ॥

> *saḥ | it | agne | astu | subhagaḥ | sudānuḥ | yaḥ | tvā | nityena |*
> *haviṣā | yaḥ |*
> *ukṣaiḥ |*
> *piprīṣati | sve | āyuṣi | duroṇe | viśvā | it | asmai | sudinā | sā | asat |*
> *iṣṭiḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यः पुमान् नित्येन यावज्जीवं संकल्पितेनाग्निहोत्रादिसाधनभूतेन हविषा त्वा त्वां
> पिप्रीषिति । प्रीणयितुमिच्छति । यश्चोक्थ्यैः शस्त्रैः प्रीण
> यितुमिच्छति सेत् स एव पुमान् सुभगः शोभनधनः सौभाग्यवान्वा सुदानुः–

> *he agne yaḥ pumān nityena yāvajjīvaṃ*
> *saṃkalpitenāgnihotrādisādhanabhūtena haviṣā tvā tvāṃ piprīṣiti |*
> *prīṇayitumicchati | yaścokṣyaiḥ śastraiḥ prīṇa*
> *yitumicchati set sa eva pumān subhagaḥ śobhanadhanaḥ*
> *saubhāgyavānvā sudānuḥ-*

> शोभनदानोपेतश्चास्तु किंच दुरोणे दुरवने कृच्छ्रलभ्ये स्वे स्वकीय आयुषि
> शतवर्षाख्ये जीवने तिष्ठतु । अस्मै यजमानाय विश्वा सर्वाणि सुदिना शोभनानि
> दिनानि भवंतु । अस्य सेष्टिः स यज्ञोऽसत् । फलसाधनसमर्थो भवतु ॥ पिप्रीषति ।
> प्रीञ् तर्पणे । धातोः कर्मण इति सन् । असत् । अस्तेर्लेट्यडागमः । इष्टिः ।
> मंत्रे वृषेत्यादिना क्तिन्नुदात्तः ॥

> *śobhanadānopetaścāstu kiṃca duroṇe duravane kṛcchralabhye sve*
> *svakīya āyuṣi*
> *śatavarṣākhye jīvane tiṣṭhatu | asmai yajamānāya viśvā sarvāṇi sudinā*
> *śobhanāni*
> *dināni bhavaṃtu | asya seṣṭiḥ sa yajño 'sat | phalasādhanasamartho*
> *bhavatu ‖ piprīṣati |*
> *prīñ tarpaṇe | dhātoḥ karmaṇa iti san | asat | asterleṭyaḍāgamaḥ | iṣṭiḥ*
> *|*
> *maṃtre vṛṣetyādinā ktinnudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, the man who with a constant (नित्येन (*nityena*)) oblation, one resolved upon for as long as he lives and serving as the means of the Agnihotra and the like, wishes to please you, and who wishes to please you with ukthya hymns (उक्षैः (*ukṣaiḥ*), read as śastras) — that very man is to be subhaga, possessed of good wealth or of good fortune, and sudānu, possessed of good giving.

Moreover, in his own life, called duroṇa because hard to obtain, that is, in a life of a hundred years, let him abide. For this yajamāna may all days be fair. His iṣṭi, that sacrifice, is to be asat, that is, capable of yielding its fruit.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- नित्येन (*nityena*)—with the eternal
- हविषा (*haviṣā*)—oblation
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- पिप्रीषति (*piprīṣati*)—wishes to satisfy
- यः (*yaḥ*)—who
- उक्षैः (*ukṣaiḥ*)—gladdens with śastra-mantras
- सः इत् (*saḥ it*)—that man himself
- सुभगः (*subhagaḥ*)—possessed of excellent wealth
- सुदानुः (*sudānuḥ*)—an excellent giver
- अस्तु (*astu*)—let him be
- दुरोणे (*duroṇe*)—arduous
- स्वे (*sve*)—his own
- आयुषि (*āyuṣi*)—let him gain a life of a hundred years
- अस्मै (*asmai*)—for this yajamāna
- विश्वा (*viśvā*)—all
- सुदिना (*sudinā*)—let the days also be auspicious
- सा इष्टिः (*sā iṣṭiḥ*)—his sacrifice
- असत् (*asat*)—let it give good fruit

Gist

O Agni, the man who wishes to satisfy you for ever with oblation, and who always gladdens you with śastra-mantras — may that same man be possessed of excellent wealth and be an excellent giver, and may he gain his arduous life of a hundred years. May all days be auspicious for this yajamāna. May his sacrifice yield good fruit.

English translation

May the liberal man ever be prosperous who propitiates you with constant oblations and praises : may all the days in his arduous life be pros- perous, and may this (his) sacrifice be productive of reward).

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अर्चा॑मि ते सुम॒तिं घोष्य॒र्वाक्सं ते॑ वा॒वाता॑ जरता॒मि॒
यं गीः ।
स्वश्वा॑स्त्वा सु॒रथा॑ मर्जयेमा॒स्मे क्ष॒त्राणि॑ धारये॒रनु॒
द्यून् ॥ ८ ॥

> *arcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣyarvāksaṃ te vāvātā jaratāmiyaṃ gīḥ |*
> *svaśvāstvā surathā marjayemāsme kṣatrāṇi dhārayeranu dyūn ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अर्चामि । ते । सुमतिं । घोषि । अर्वाक् । सं । ते । वनाता । जरतां । इयं । गीः।
> सुअश्वाः । त्वा । सुरथाः । मर्जयेम । अस्मे इति । क्षत्राणि । धारयेः । अनु ।
> द्यून् ॥ ८ ॥

> *arcāmi | te | sumatiṃ | ghoṣi | arvāk | saṃ | te | vanātā | jaratāṃ |*
> *iyaṃ | gīḥ|*
> *suaśvāḥ | tvā | surathāḥ | marjayema | asme iti | kṣatrāṇi | dhārayeḥ |*
> *anu |*
> *dyūn ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उखासंभरणीयेष्टावग्नेः क्षत्रभृतोऽर्चामि त इति याज्या । सूत्रितं च ।
> अर्चामि ते सुमतिं घोष्यर्वागितीदंप्रभृतिकर्मणां । आ. ४–१ । इति ॥
> हे अग्ने ते तव सुमतिमनुग्रहकरां शोभनां बुद्धिमर्चामि । पूजयामि ।
> ववाता पुनःपुनस्त्वामभिगच्छंतीयमुच्यमाना गीर्वाग्घोषि घोषयुक्तं
> यथा भवति तथार्वाक् त्वदभिमुखु ते त्वां सं जरतां । स्तौतु । वयमपि
> स्वश्वाः शोभनाश्वोपेताः सुरथाश्च । उपलक्षणमेतत् । पुत्रपौत्रादिभिः सहिताः
> संतस्त्वां मर्जयेम । अलंकुर्याम । परिचरेमेति यावत् । त्वं तु अनु
> द्यूनन्वहमस्मै अस्मासु क्षत्राणि धनानि धारयेः । निधेहि ॥ घोषि । घुष शब्दने ।
> औणादिक इन्। नित्त्वादाद्युदात्तः । नावाता । वा गतिगंधनयोरित्यस्य यज्लुगंतस्य
> निष्ठायां रूपं । मर्जयेम । मृजू शौचालंकारयोः । ण्यंतस्य लिजु रूपं ।
> वृद्धभावश्चांदसः ॥

> *ukhāsaṃbharaṇīyeṣṭāvagneḥ kṣatrabhṛto 'rcāmi ta iti yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *arcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣyarvāgitīdaṃprabhṛtikarmaṇāṃ | ā. 4-1 | iti ‖*
> *hè agne te tava sumatimanugrahakarāṃ śobhanāṃ buddhimarcāmi | pūjayāmi |*
> *vavātā punaḥpunastvāmabhigacchaṃtīyamucyamānā gīrvāgghoṣi ghoṣayuktaṃ*
> *yathā bhavati tathārvāk tvadabhimukhu te tvāṃ saṃ jaratāṃ | stautu | vayamapi*
> *svaśvāḥ śobhanāśvopetāḥ surathāśca | upalakṣaṇametat | putrapautrādibhiḥ sahitāḥ*
> *saṃtastvāṃ marjayema | alaṃkuryāma | paricaremeti yāvat | tvaṃ tu anu*
> *dyūnanvahamasmai asmāsu kṣatrāṇi dhanāni dhārayeḥ | nidhehi ‖ ghoṣi | ghuṣa śabdane |*
> *auṇādika in| nittvādādyudāttaḥ | nāvātā | vā gatigaṃdhanayorityasya yajlugaṃtasya*
> *niṣṭhāyāṃ rūpaṃ | marjayema | mṛjū śaucālaṃkārayoḥ | ṇyaṃtasya liju rūpaṃ |*
> *vṛddhabhāvaścāṃdasaḥ ‖*

Summary

This verse is the yājyā of Agni Kṣatrabhṛt in the Ukhāsaṃbharaṇīya oblation (iṣṭi). The sūtra says: अर्चामि ते सुमतिं घोष्यर्वागितीदंप्रभृतिकर्मणां (*arcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣyarvāgitīdaṃprabhṛtikarmaṇāṃ*) (Ā. 4-1).

"O Agni, I honour your good mind (sumati), which means your gracious and excellent thought. This speech (gīḥ) that is now uttered, going to you again and again, let it praise you (jaratām) facing you, in such a way that it is full of sound (ghoṣi). We also, having good horses (svaśvāḥ) and good chariots, are meant here as accompanied by sons, grandsons and the rest. We would adorn (marjayema) you, that is, serve you. You, day after day, place (dhārayeḥ) among us the kṣatrāṇi, that is, riches."

Word-to-word meaning

- ते (*te*)—your
- सुमतिं (*sumatiṃ*)—the gracious mind
- अर्चामि (*arcāmi*)—I worship
- ववाता (*vavātā*)—being recited, praising you again and again
- इयं गीः (*iyaṃ gīḥ*)—this speech
- घोषि (*ghoṣi*)—sounding
- अर्वाक् (*arvāk*)—facing you
- ते (*te*)—you
- सं जरताः (*saṃ jaratāḥ*)—let it praise
- स्वश्वाः (*svaśvāḥ*)—those who have excellent horses
- सुरथाः (*surathāḥ*)—those who are accompanied by sons, grandsons and the rest
- त्वा मर्जयेम (*tvā marjayema*)—we adorn you
- अनु द्यून् (*anu dyūn*)—every day
- अस्मे (*asme*)—among us
- क्षेत्राणि (*kṣetrāṇi*)—riches[?391]
- धारयेः (*dhārayeḥ*)—place

Gist

O Agni, I worship your gracious mind. May this speech, recited in praise of you again and again, sound out, turn towards you and praise you. Having excellent horses and being accompanied by sons, grandsons and the rest, we adorn you. Grant that we may have wealth every day.

English translation

I reverence your good favour, Agni ; may this reiterated and resounding hymn convey due praise to your presence : may we be possessed of good horses and good cars, that we may pay you homage; and daily bestow upon us riches.

Special Topics

In the iṣṭi called Ukhāsaṃbharaṇa, in the Kṣatrabhṛt homa, this ṛk अर्चामि ते (*arcāmi te*) is to be used as a yājyā mantra. This is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra अर्चामि ते सुमतिं घोष्यर्वागितीदंप्रभृतिकर्मणां (*arcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣyarvāgitīdaṃprabhṛtikarmaṇāṃ*) (Ā. 4-1).

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒ह त्वा॒ भूर्या च॑रे॒दुप॒ त्मन्दोषा॑वस्तर्दीदि॒वांस॒मनु॒ द्यून् ।
क्रीळ॑न्तस्त्वा सु॒मन॑सः सपेमा॒भि द्यु॒म्ना त॑स्थि॒वांसो॒ जना॑नाम् ॥ ९ ॥

> *iha tvā bhūryā caredupa tmandoṣāvastardīdivāṃsamanu dyūn |*
> *krīḷantastvā sumanasaḥ sapemābhi dyumnā tasthivāṃso janānām ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इह । त्वा । भूरि । आ । चरेत् । उप । त्मन् । दोषावस्तः । दीदिवांसं । अनु ।
> द्यून् ।
> क्रीळंतः । त्वा । सुमनसः । सपेम । अभि । द्युम्ना । तस्थिवांसः । जनानां ॥ ९ ॥

> *iha | tvā | bhūri | ā | caret | upa | tman | doṣāvastaḥ | dīdivāṃsaṃ |*
> *anu |*
> *dyūn |*
> *krīḻaṃtaḥ | tvā | sumanasaḥ | sapema | abhi | dyumnā | tasthivāṃsaḥ*
> *| janānāṃ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे आग्ने इह रक्षोहननाख्ये कर्मणि यद्वास्मिल्लोके यः पुरुषो दोषावस्ता रात्रावहनि च दीदिवांसं दीप्यमानं त्वामनु द्यूनन्वहं त्मन् आत्मना
> स्वयमेवोप समीपे भूरि भूयिष्ठं यथा भवति तथा चरेत् । परिचरति । तस्माद्वयमपि जनानां शत्रूणां द्युम्ना द्युम्नानि धनान्यभि तस्थिनांसत्वप्रसादादात्मसात्कुर्वंतोऽत एव क्रीळंतः स्वे स्वे गृहे पुत्रपौत्रादिभिः सह संक्रीडमानास्तथा सुमनसः शोभनमनस्काः संतस्त्वां सपेम । परिचरेम । यद्वा । दोषावस्तरिति संबुद्धिः । दोषाया रात्रिकृतस्य तमसो वस्तराच्छादयितर्निवारयितः ॥
> त्मन् । आत्मनब्दस्य तृतीयायाः सुपां सुलुगिति लुक् । मंत्रेष्याज्यादेरात्मन इत्याकारलोपः । दोषावस्तः । द्वंद्वपक्षे कार्तकौजपादयश्चति पूर्वपदप्रकृतिस्वरः । संबुद्धिपक्ष आमंत्रितस्य पादादित्वात् षाष्टिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं । सपेम । षप समवाये । लिजु रूपं । निघातः ॥

> *he āgne iha rakṣohananākhye karmaṇi yadvāsmilloke yaḥ puruṣo doṣāvastā rātrāvahani ca dīdivāṃsaṃ dīpyamānaṃ tvāmanu dyūnanvahaṃ tman ātmanā*
> *svayamevopa samīpe bhūri bhūyiṣṭhaṃ yathā bhavati tathā caret | paricarati | tasmādvayamapi janānāṃ śatrūṇāṃ dyumnā dyumnāni dhanānyabhi tasthināṃsatvaprasādādātmasātkurvaṃto 'ta eva krīḻaṃtaḥ sve sve gṛhe putrapautrādibhiḥ saha saṃkrīḍamānāstathā sumanasaḥ śobhanamanaskāḥ saṃtastvāṃ sapema | paricarema | yadvā | doṣāvastariti saṃbuddhiḥ | doṣāyā rātrikṛtasya tamaso vastarācchādayitarnivārayitaḥ ‖*
> *tman | ātmanabdasya tṛtīyāyāḥ supāṃ sulugiti luk | maṃtreṣyājyāderātmana ityākāralopaḥ | doṣāvastaḥ | dvaṃdvapakṣe kārtakaujapādayaścati*

> *pūrvapadaprakṛtisvaraḥ | saṃbuddhipakṣa āmaṃtritasya pādāditvāt*
> *ṣāṣṭikamādyudāttatvaṃ | sapema | ṣapa*
> *samavāye | liju rūpaṃ | nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, here, that is, in this rite called the slaying of the rakṣas, or else in this world, whatever man serves you, shining (dīdivāṃsam) by night and by day, every day, of himself (tman, by his own self), near you and abundantly (bhūri), therefore we also serve you. We make our own, through your favour, the dyumnā of the enemies (janānām), that is, their riches. For that very reason we sport (krīḷantaḥ), each in his own house, playing with sons, grandsons and the rest. We are well-minded (sumanasaḥ), of good mind, and so we serve you (sapema)."

Or else: दोषावस्तः (*doṣāvastaḥ*) is a vocative, meaning "O you who cover or ward off (vastar) the darkness (doṣā) caused by night."

Word-to-word meaning

- इह (*iha*)—in this world
- दोषावस्तः (*doṣāvastaḥ*)—night and day
- दीदिवांसं (*dīdivāṃsaṃ*)—shining
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- अनु द्यून् (*anu dyūn*)—every day
- त्मन् (*tman*)—each one, of his own inner impulse
- उप (*upa*)—near you
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—exceedingly
- आ चरेत् (*ā caret*)—let him attend upon
- जनानां (*janānāṃ*)—of the enemy people
- द्युम्ना (*dyumnā*)—the riches
- अभि तस्थिवांसः (*abhi tasthivāṃsaḥ*)—those who make them their own
- क्रीळंतः (*krīḷaṃtaḥ*)—those who rejoice with sons, grandsons and the rest
- सुमनसः (*sumanasaḥ*)—those whose minds are full of devotion

- त्वा सपेम (*tvā sapema*)—we attend upon you (the Kannada prints पचरिसुत्तेवे (*pacarisuttevè*))[?392]

Gist

O Agni, in this world may every man, of his own inner impulse, worship and attend upon you, who shine night and day, every day. By your favour we make our own the riches of enemy people, we rejoice with sons, grandsons and the rest, and with devout minds we attend upon you.

English translation

May every one of his own accord diligently worship you, shining in the (hall) morning and evening, every day : thus, sporting in our dwellings, (enjoying) the wealth of (hostile) man, may we with happy hearts worship you.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्त्वा॒ स्वश्व॑ः सुहि॒रण्यो॒ अ॑ग्न उप॒याति॒ वसु॑मता॒ रथे॑न ।
तस्य॑ त्रा॒ता भ॑वसि॒ तस्य॒ सखा॒ यस्त॑ आति॒थ्यमा॑नु॒षग्जुजो॑षत् ॥ १० ॥

> *yastvā svaśvaḥ suhiraṇyo agna upayāti vasumatā rathena |*
> *tasya trātā bhavasi tasya sakhā yasta ātithyamānuṣagjujoṣat ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । त्वा । सुअश्वः । सुहिरण्यः । अग्ने । उपयाति । वसुमता । रथेन ।
> तस्य । त्राता । भवसि । तस्य । सखा । यः । ते । आतिथ्यं । अनुषक् । जुजोषत् ॥ १० ॥

> *yaḥ | tvā | suaśvaḥ | suhiraṇyaḥ | agne | upayāti | vasumatā | rathena |*
> *tasya | trātā | bhavasi | tasya | sakhā | yaḥ | te | ātithyaṃ | anuṣak | jujoṣat ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यः पुमान् स्वश्वः शोभनाश्वोपेतः सुहिरण्यो यागयोग्यधनोपेतो वसुमता
> व्रीह्यादिधनयुक्तन रथेन सहितः सन् त्वामुपयाति । परिचरणार्थं तव समीपं गच्छति । तस्य
> पुंसस्त्राता सर्वदुरितेभ्यो रक्षको भवसि ।
> यश्च पुमान् ते तदातिथ्यमतिथियोग्यां पूजामानुषगनुक्रमेण जुजोषत्
> प्रापयति तस्यः पुंसः सखा तदुचितफलप्रदानेनोपकर्ता भवसि ॥ उपयाति । सह
> सुपेत्यत्र सहेति योगविभागात्समासः । तिपः पित्त्वादनुदात्तत्वे धातुस्वरः । तिजु
> चोदात्तवतीति गतेर्निघातः । आतिथ्यं अतिथिशब्दात्तादर्थ्ये अतिथेर्ञ इति इत्यप्रत्ययः ।
> प्रत्ययस्वरः । जुजोषत् । जोषयतेर्लजि बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः ।
> अडागमः । छंदस्युभयथेति तिप आर्धधातुकत्वाण्णिलोपः । अभ्यस्तानामादिरित्याद्युदात्तः ॥

> *he agne yaḥ pumān svaśvaḥ śobhanāśvopetaḥ suhiraṇyo yāgayogyadhanopeto vasumatā vrīhyādidhanayuktana rathena sahitaḥ san tvāmupayāti | paricaraṇārthaṃ tava samīpaṃ gacchati | tasya puṃsastrātā sarvaduritebhyo rakṣako bhavasi |*
> *yaśca pumān te tadātithyamatithiyogyāṃ pūjāmānuṣaganukrameṇa jujoṣat*
> *prāpayati tasyaḥ puṃsaḥ sakhā taducitaphalapradānenopakartā bhavasi ‖ upayāti | saha*
> *supetyatra saheti yogavibhāgātsamāsaḥ | tipaḥ pittvādanudāttatve dhātusvaraḥ | tiju*
> *codāttavatīti gaternighātaḥ | ātithyaṃ atithiśabdāttādarthye atitherña iti ityapratyayaḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ | jujoṣat | joṣayaterlaji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ |*
> *aḍāgamaḥ | chaṃdasyubhayatheti tipa ārdhadhātukatvāṇṇilopaḥ | abhyastānāmādirityādyudāttaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Agni, the man who has good horses (svaśva) and good gold (suhiraṇya), that is, wealth fit for sacrifice, and who comes to you (upayāti) together with a chariot (rathena) laden with wealth (vasumatā), such as grain and the like, going near you in order to attend upon you: of that man you are the protector (trātā), the guardian from all misfortunes. And the man who offers you in due order (ānuṣak) the hospitality (ātithya), the worship fit for a guest, of him you are the friend (sakhā); you are his benefactor by giving him the fruit that befits it."

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- स्वश्वः (*svaśvaḥ*)—one who has excellent horses
- सुहिरण्यः (*suhiraṇyaḥ*)—one who has wealth that is an instrument of sacrifice
- वसुमता (*vasumatā*)—wealth-laden
- रथेन (*rathena*)—together with a chariot
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- उपयाति (*upayāti*)—approaches and worships
- तस्य (*tasya*)—of that man
- त्राता (*trātā*)—protector
- भवसि (*bhavasi*)—you become
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the man who
- ते (*te*)—your
- आतिथ्यं (*ātithyaṃ*)—worship fit for a guest
- आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)—according to rule
- जुजोषत् (*jujoṣat*)—offers
- तस्य (*tasya*)—of that man
- सखा (*sakhā*)—you are the friend

Gist

O Agni, the man who has excellent horses and wealth that is an instrument of sacrifice, and who approaches and worships you together with a wealth-laden chariot: you are the protector of that man. The man who offers according to rule the worship due to you as a guest: to that man you are a friend.

English translation

You, Agni, are the protector of him who, possessed of good horses and a golden car, approches you with a chariot laden with wealth : you are the friend of him who gratifies you by the due performance of hospitality to you.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हो रु॑जामि ब॒न्धुता॒ वचो॑भि॒स्तन्मा॑ पि॒तुर्गोत॑मा॒दन्वि॑याय ।
त्वं नो॑ अ॒स्य वच॑सश्चिकिद्धि॒ होत॑र्यविष्ठ सुक्रतो॒ दमू॑नाः ॥ ११ ॥

> *maho rujāmi bandhutā vacobhistanmā piturgotamādanviyāya |*
> *tvaṃ no asya vacasaścikiddhi hotaryaviṣṭha sukrato damūnāḥ ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महः । रुजामि । बंधुता । वचःभिः । तत् । मा । पितुः । गोतमात् । अनु ।
> इयाय ।
> त्वं । नः । अस्य । वचसः । चिकिद्दि । होतः । यविष्ठ । सुक्रतो इति सुक्रतो
> दमूनाः ॥ ११ ॥

> *mahaḥ | rujāmi | baṃdhutā | vacaḥbhiḥ | tat | mā | pituḥ | gotamāt |*
> *anu |*
> *iyāya |*
> *tvaṃ | naḥ | asya | vacasaḥ | cikiddi | hotaḥ | yaviṣṭha | sukrato iti*
> *sukrato*
> *damūnāḥ ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे होतर्देवानामह्वातर्यविष्ठ युवतम सुक्रतो शोभनप्रज्ञ हे
> अग्ने वचोभिस्त्वदुद्देशेन कृतैः स्तोत्रैः समुपजाता येयं बंधुता बंधुभावस्तया बंधुतया महो
> महतो राक्षासान्रुजामि । भनज्मि । तत्तादृशं स्तोत्रात्मकं वचः पितुरुत्पादयितुर्गोतमादृषेः
> सकाशान्मा नामदेवं मामन्वि–

> *he hotardevānāmahvātaryaviṣṭha yuvatama sukrato śobhanaprajña he*
> *agne vacobhistvaduddeśena kṛtaiḥ stotraiḥ samupajātā yeyaṃ baṃdhutā*
> *baṃdhubhāvastayā baṃdhutayā maho mahato rākṣāsānrujāmi |*
> *bhanajmi | tattādṛśaṃ stotrātmakaṃ vacaḥ*
> *piturutpādayiturgotamādṛṣeḥ sakāśānmā nāmadevaṃ māmanvi-*

> याय । दमूना दांतमना दानमना वा शत्रूणामुपक्षपयिता वा तादृशस्त्वं
> नोऽस्मदीयस्यास्य वचसः स्तोत्रात्मकमेतद्वाक्यं चिकिद्धि । जानीहि ॥ चिकिद्धि । कित
> ज्ञाने । चौहोत्यादिकः । लोटि रूपं । होतः । पादादित्वात् षाष्ठिकमाद्युदात्तत्वं । इतरयोस्तु
> नामंत्रिते समानाधिकरण इति प्रथमस्याविद्यमानवद्भावनिषेधादपादादित्वेन निघातः ॥

> *yāya | damūnā dāṃtamanā dānamanā vā śatrūṇāmupakṣapayitā vā*
> *tādṛśastvaṃ*
> *no 'smadīyasyāsya vacasaḥ stotrātmakametadvākyaṃ cikiddi | jānīhi ‖*
> *cikiddi | kita*
> *jñāne | cauhotyādikaḥ | loṭi rūpaṃ | hotaḥ | pādāditvāt*
> *ṣāṣṭhikamādyudāttatvaṃ | itarayostu nāmaṃtrite samānādhikaraṇa iti*
> *prathamasyāvidyamānavadbhāvaniṣedhādapādāditvena nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O Hotṛ, caller of the gods, O Yaviṣṭha, youngest, O Sukratu, of good understanding, O Agni: by the kinship (bandhutā) that has arisen through praises (vacobhiḥ) made with you as their aim, I crush (rujāmi), that is, I break, the great (mahaḥ) rākṣasas. Such a speech, of the nature of praise, has come (anviyāya) to me from my father (pituḥ), the seer Gotama." The text then reads मा नामदेवं मामन्वि (*mā nāmadevaṃ māmanvi*) …[?393], breaking off at the page end.[?394]

The sentence continues: अन्वियाय (*anviyāya*), "has come to me". Damūnāḥ means one whose mind is self-controlled, or whose mind is given to giving, or one who destroys enemies. "Such as you are, know (cikiddhi), understand, this speech of ours, this sentence of the nature of praise."

Word-to-word meaning

- होतः (*hotaḥ*)—O caller of the gods to the sacrifice
- यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)—O most youthful
- सुक्रतो (*sukrato*)—O Agni, who have excellent understanding
- वचोभिः (*vacobhiḥ*)—arisen from the praises addressed to you
- बंधुता (*baṃdhutā*)—by the bond of kinship
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—even the rākṣasas who have great power
- रुजामि (*rujāmi*)—I am able to destroy
- तत् (*tat*)—such a word of praise
- पितुः (*pituḥ*)—of our father
- गोतमात् (*gotamāt*)—from the seer Gotama (printed गोतमऋषियिंद (*gotamarṣiyiṃda*))
- मा (*mā*)—to me
- अन्वियाय (*anviyāya*)—has come
- दमूनाः (*damūnāḥ*)—you who have the power to destroy enemies
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- अस्य वचसः (*asya vacasaḥ*)—of this word of praise
- चिकिद्दि (*cikiddi*)—know (the Kannada adds "its nature")

Gist

O Agni, caller of the gods to the sacrifice, most youthful, of excellent understanding: through the force of the bond of kinship arisen from the praises addressed to you, I am able to destroy even the rākṣasas of great power. Such a word of praise has come to me from our father, the seer Gotama. You who have the power to destroy enemies, know the nature of this word of praise of ours.

English translation

Invoker (of the gods), youngest (of the deities) ; possessed of excellent wisdom, through the alliance (with you produced) by holy texts, which came to me from my father Gotama, I demolish the powerful (demons) : you are the humbler (of foes) ; be cognizant of our praises,

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अस्व॑प्नजस्त॒रण॑यः सु॒शेवा॒ अत॑न्द्रासोऽवृ॒का अश्र॑मिष्ठाः ।
ते पा॒यव॑ः स॒ध्र्य॑ञ्चो नि॒षद्या॒ग्ने तव॑ नः पान्त्वमूर ॥ १२ ॥

> *asvapnajastaraṇayaḥ suśevā atandrāso 'vṛkā aśramiṣṭhāḥ |*
> *te pāyavaḥ sadhryañco niṣadyāgne tava naḥ pāntvamūra ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्वप्नजः । शरणयः । सुशेवाः । अतंद्रासः । अवृकाः । अश्रमिष्ठाः ।
> ते । पायवः । सध्यंचः । निसद्य । अग्ने । तव । नः । पांतु । अमूर ॥ १२ ॥

> *asvapnajaḥ | śaraṇayaḥ | suśevāḥ | ataṃdrāsaḥ | avṛkāḥ | aśramiṣṭhāḥ |*
> *te | pāyavaḥ | sadhyaṃcaḥ | nisadya | agne | tava | naḥ | pāṃtu | amūra ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अमूर अमूढ सर्वज्ञ । यद्वा । अमूर अप्रतिहतगते हे अग्ने अस्वप्नजोऽस्वपंतः । जागरूका इति यावत् । तरणयः सततगमनस्वभावा आपद्भ्यस्तारका
> ना सुशेवाः सुसुखा अतंद्रासोऽतंद्रा अनलसाः सर्वदोद्युक्ता अवृका अहिंसका
> अश्रमिष्ठा अश्रांततमाः सध्रंचः परस्परं संगताः पायवो रक्षकास्ते तादृशास्तव
> रश्मयो निषद्यास्मद्यज्ञे निषण्णा भूत्वा नोऽस्मान्पांतु। रक्षंतु ॥ अस्वप्नजः । स्वपितृषोर्नजिज् प्रत्ययः । मध्येवग्रहश्चांदसः । सध्रंचः । सहपूर्णादंचतेः क्विप् ।

> सहस्य सध्रिरिति सहस्य सध्रादेशः । सध्रादेशस्यांतोदात्तत्वनिपातनाद्यणादेश उदात्तस्वरितयोरिति स्वरितत्वं । अमूर । मुह वैचित्ये । निष्ठायां ढकारस्य रेफश्चांदसः । यद्वा । मूज् बंधने । औणादिको रक् ॥

> *amūra amūḍha sarvajña | yadvā | amūra apratihatagate he agne*
> *asvapnajo 'svapaṃtaḥ | jāgarūkā iti yāvat | taraṇayaḥ*
> *satatagamanasvabhāvā āpadbhyastārakā*
> *nā suśevāḥ susukhā ataṃdrāso 'taṃdrā analasāḥ sarvadodyuktā avṛkā ahiṃsakā*
> *aśramiṣṭhā aśrāṃtatamāḥ sadhraṃcaḥ parasparaṃ saṃgatāḥ pāyavo rakṣakāste tādṛśāstava*
> *raśmayo niṣadyāsmadyajñè niṣaṇṇā bhūtvā no 'smānpāṃtu| rakṣaṃtu ||*
> *asvapnajaḥ | svapitṛṣornajij pratyayaḥ | madhyevagrahaścāṃdasaḥ |*
> *sadhraṃcaḥ | sahapūrṇādaṃcateḥ kvip |*
> *sahasya sadhririti sahasya sadhrādeśaḥ |*
> *sadhrādeśasyāṃtodāttatvanipātanādyaṇādeśa*
> *udāttasvaritayoriti svaritatvaṃ | amūra | muha vaicitye | niṣṭhāyāṃ ḍhakārasya rephaścāṃdasaḥ | yadvā | mūj baṃdhane | auṇādiko rak ||*

Summary

"Amūra" means unconfused, all-knowing; or else, O Agni, of unobstructed course. Sāyaṇa glosses the epithets of the rays as follows. अस्वप्नजः (*asvapnajaḥ*): not sleeping, that is, watchful. तरणयः (*taraṇayaḥ*): of constantly moving nature, rescuers from calamities. सुशेवाः (*suśevāḥ*): very pleasant. अतंद्रासः (*ataṃdrāsaḥ*): without drowsiness, not idle, always active. अवृकाः (*avṛkāḥ*): not harming. अश्रमिष्ठाः (*aśramiṣṭhāḥ*): most untiring. सध्रंचः (*sadhraṃcaḥ*): united with one another. पायवः (*pāyavaḥ*): protectors. Such rays of yours, having settled down at our sacrifice, are to protect us.

Word-to-word meaning

- अमूर (*amūra*)—all-knowing
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अस्वप्नजः (*asvapnajaḥ*)—watchful
- तरणयः (*taraṇayaḥ*)—of constant movement
- सुशेवाः (*suśevāḥ*)—bestowing comfort

- आतंद्रासः (*ātaṃdrāsaḥ*)—without idleness
- अवृकाः (*avṛkāḥ*)—free from violence
- अश्रमिष्ठाः (*aśramiṣṭhāḥ*)—free from weariness
- सध्र्यंचः (*sadhryaṃcaḥ*)—united with one another
- पायवः (*pāyavaḥ*)—protecting
- ते तव (*te tava*)—those rays of yours
- निषद्य (*niṣadya*)—having occupied this place of our sacrifice
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- पांतु (*pāṃtu*)—let them protect

Gist

O all-knowing Agni, may those well-known rays of yours, which are watchful, of constant movement, bestowers of comfort, free from idleness, free from violence, free from weariness and united with one another, occupy this place of our sacrifice and protect us.

English translation

All-wise Agni, may your protecting (rays), unslumbering, alert, propitious, unslothful, benignant, unwearied co-operating, having taken their place (at this sacrifice), preserve us.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ये पा॒यवो॑ मामते॒यं ते॑ अग्ने॒ पश्यं॑न्तो अ॒न्धं दु॑रि॒ताद॑रक्षन् ।
र॒रक्ष॒ तान्सु॒कृतो॑ वि॒श्ववे॑दा॒ दिप्सं॑न्त॒ इद्रि॒पवो॒ नाह॑ देभुः ॥ १३ ॥

> *ye pāyavo māmateyaṃ te agne paśyanto andhaṃ duritādarakṣan |*
> *rarakṣa tānsukṛto viśvavedā dipsanta idripavo nāha debhuḥ || 13 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> ये । पायवः । मामतेयं । ते । अग्ने । पश्यंतः । अंधं । दुःइतात् । अरक्षन् ।
> ररक्ष । तान् । सुकृतः । विश्ववेदाः । दिप्संतः । इत् । रिपवः । न । अह । देभुः॥१३॥

> *ye | pāyavaḥ | māmateyaṃ | te | agne | paśyaṃtaḥ | aṃdhaṃ | duḥitāt*
> *| arakṣan |*
> *rarakṣa | tān | sukṛtaḥ | viśvavedāḥ | dipsaṃtaḥ | it | ripavaḥ | na |*
> *aha | debhuḥ‖13‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अत्रेयमैतिहासिकी कथा । उचथ्यस्य गर्भिणीं ममतानामधेयां भार्यां
> तदनुजो बृहस्पतिरचकमत । तस्यां रेत अधित्सुं तु बृहस्पतिं गर्भस्थं रेतोऽब्रवीत् । रेतोऽत्र
> मा सैक्षीरहमत्र वसामिति। एवमुक्तो बृहस्पतिर्निरुद्धरेतस्कः
> सन् रेतोरूपं गर्भं शशाप । जात्यंधत्वरूपं दीर्घं तमः प्राप्नुहीति । ततस्तस्यां दीर्घतमा
> अजनिष्ठ । स चांध्यपरिहारायाग्निं स्तुत्वा चक्षुरलभतेति। तदिदानीमाह । हे अग्ने पायवो
> रक्षकाः पश्यंतोऽंधोऽयमिति कृषादृष्टा पश्यंतस्ते
> तव ये रश्मयो मामतेयं ममतायाः पुत्रमंधं चक्षुर्हिनं दीर्घतमसं
> दुरितादांध्यलक्षणाच्छापादरक्षणन् चक्षुष्पदानेनापालयन् । विश्वदेवा विश्वप्रज्ञो
> भवान् सुकृतः शोभनं चक्षुष्पदानादिकर्म कृतवतस्तान्नस्मिन्नरक्ष । आदरेण
> परिगृह्य पालयति । तेषां परिग्रहसिद्धिरभिधीयते । दिप्पंत इत् दंभितुं परिभवितुमिच्छंत एव
> रिपवः शत्रव एनं दीर्घतमसं नाह देभुः । नैव परिभवंति खलु ॥
> मामतेयं । ममताया अपत्यमित्यर्थे स्त्रीभ्यो ढक् । दिप्पंतः । दन्नु दंभे ।
> सनीवंतर्धेत्यादिना इडभावः । दंभ इच्चीतीकारः । देभुः ।
> श्रंथिग्रंथिदंभिष्टंजीनामपसंख्यानमिति लिटः कित्वादुपधालोपः ॥

> *atreyamaitihāsikī kathā | ucathyasya garbhiṇīṃ mamatānāmadheyāṃ*
> *bhāryāṃ*
> *tadanujo bṛhaspatiracakamata | tasyāṃ reta adhitsuṃ tu bṛhaspatiṃ*
> *garbhasthaṃ reto 'bravīt | reto 'tra mā saikṣīrahamatra vasāmiti|*
> *evamukto bṛhaspatirniruddharetaskaḥ*
> *san retorūpaṃ garbhaṃ śaśāpa | jātyaṃdhatvarūpaṃ dīrghaṃ tamaḥ*
> *prāpnuhīti | tatastasyāṃ dīrghatamā ajaniṣṭha | sa*
> *cāṃdhyaparihārāyāgniṃ stutvā cakṣuralabhateti| tadidānīmāha | he*
> *agne pāyavo rakṣakāḥ paśyaṃto 'ṃdho 'yamiti kṛṣādṛṣṭā paśyaṃtaste*
> *tava ye raśmayo māmateyaṃ mamatāyāḥ putramaṃdhaṃ cakṣurhinaṃ*
> *dīrghatamasaṃ*
> *duritādāṃdhyalakṣaṇācchāpādarakṣaṇan cakṣuṣpadānenāpālayan |*

> *viśvadevā viśvaprajño*
> *bhavān sukṛtaḥ śobhanaṃ cakṣuṣpadānādikarma*
> *kṛtavatastānrasminnarakṣa | ādareṇa*
> *parigṛhya pālayati | teṣāṃ parigrahasiddhirabhidhīyate | dippaṃta it*
> *daṃbhituṃ paribhavitumicchaṃta eva ripavaḥ śatrava enaṃ*
> *dīrghatamasaṃ nāha debhuḥ | naiva paribhavaṃti khalu ‖*
> *māmateyaṃ | mamatāyā apatyamityarthè strībhyo ḍhak | dippaṃtaḥ |*
> *dannu daṃbhe |*
> *sanīvaṃtardhetyādinā iḍabhāvaḥ | daṃbha iccītīkāraḥ | debhuḥ |*
> *śraṃthigraṃthidaṃbhiṣṭaṃjīnāmapasaṃkhyānamiti liṭaḥ*
> *kitvādupadhālopaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa first gives the traditional story. Bṛhaspati, the younger brother of Ucathya, desired Ucathya's pregnant wife, named Mamatā. When he wished to deposit his seed in her, the child in the womb told him: "Do not pour seed here; I dwell here." Thus addressed, Bṛhaspati, his seed obstructed, cursed the embryo: "Obtain long darkness in the form of congenital blindness." Then Dīrghatamas was born of her, and to remove his blindness he praised Agni and obtained sight. This is what the verse now says. O Agni, those protectors, your rays, looking on him with the thought "this one is blind," protected Māmateya, the son of Mamatā, blind, that is, Dīrghatamas, from misfortune, that is, from the curse of blindness, by giving him eyes. You, all-knowing, protected those rays that had done good deeds such as the giving of sight, taking them to yourself with regard. The accomplishment of their being so taken is now stated: the enemies, even while wishing to injure and overcome this Dīrghatamas, did not overcome him.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- पायवः (*pāyavaḥ*)—protecting
- पश्यंतः (*paśyaṃtaḥ*)—looking with a gracious eye
- ते (*te*)—your
- ये (*ye*)—those very rays which

- मामतेयु (*māmateyu*)—the son of Mamatā
- अंधं (*aṃdhaṃ*)—blind Dīrghatamas
- दुरितात् (*duritāt*)—from the sin in the form of a curse
- अरक्षन् (*arakṣan*)—protected
- विश्ववेदाः (*viśvavedāḥ*)—you who are all-knowing
- सुकृतः (*sukṛtaḥ*)—having excellent works
- तान् (*tān*)—those rays
- ररक्ष (*rarakṣa*)—protect
- दिप्संत इत् (*dipsaṃta it*)—even though their purpose was destruction
- रिपवः (*ripavaḥ*)—enemies
- नाह देभुः (*nāha debhuḥ*)—could not harm

Gist

O Agni, those rays of yours, protecting and looking with a gracious eye, protected Dīrghatamas, the son of Mamatā and blind, from the sin in the form of a curse. You, the all-knowing, protect those rays that have excellent works. Even though their purpose was destruction, the enemies could not harm him.

English translation

Those your protecting (rays), Agni, which, beholding (what had chanced), preserved the blind son of Mamata from misfortune : he, knowing all things, cherished those benevolent (rays), and his enemies, intending to destroy him, wrought him no harm.

Special Topics

मामतेयं (*māmateyaṃ*)—Regarding the protection of the son of the woman named Mamatā, the commentator has told a historical story. Mamatā, the wife of the sage named Ucathya, was pregnant. Then Bṛhaspati, the younger brother of Ucathya, saw that woman, was infatuated, became attached to her and had intercourse with her. At the time of the emission of seed, the child who was in the womb said to Bṛhaspati: "O Bṛhaspati, I am now in the womb; therefore do not discharge your seed into this woman's womb." Hearing this, Bṛhaspati became angry with that child in the womb, who had obstructed him at the time of releasing the seed, and pronounced a curse that the child in the womb should be born blind. Therefore the child born of that woman was born blind and became a sage famed by the name Dīrghatamāḥ (since he could not see, it always appeared to him as if it were long darkness, dīrgham tamaḥ). There is the narrative that this sage Dīrghatamāḥ praised Agni and obtained his eyes (sight). That very matter is explained here by the sentence मामतेयं दुरितात् अरक्षन् (*māmateyaṃ duritāt arakṣan*).

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वया॑ व॒यं सं॑ध॒न्य१॒॑स्त्वोता॒स्तव॒ प्रणी॑त्यश्याम॒ वाजा॑न् ।
उ॒भा शंसा॑ सूदय सत्यतातेऽनुष्ठु॒या कृं॑णुह्यह्रयाण ॥ १४ ॥

> *tvayā vayaṃ sadhanyastvotāstava praṇītyaśyāma vājān |*
> *ubhā śaṃsā sūdaya satyatāte 'nuṣṭhuyā kṛṇuhyahrayāṇa ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वया । वयं । सधन्यः । त्वालूताः । तव । प्रनीती । अश्याम । वाजान् ।
> उभा । शंसा । सूदय । सत्यताते । अनुष्टुया । कृणुहि । आह्रयाण ॥ १४ ॥

> *tvayā | vayaṃ | sadhanyaḥ | tvālūtāḥ | tava | pranītī | aśyāma | vājān |*
> *ubhā | śaṃsā | sūdaya | satyatāte | anuṣṭuyā | kṛṇuhi | āhrayāṇa ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अप्रयाण अलज्ञितगमन । अप्रयाणोऽह्नीतयान इति यास्कः । तादृश हे
> अग्ने वयं स्तोतारस्त्वया सधन्यस्वप्रसादात्समानधनास्तोतास्त्वया
> रक्षिता वयं तव प्रणीती प्रणीत्या तव प्रेरणेनानुज्ञया वाजानन्नान्यश्याम ।
> प्राप्नुयाम । हे सत्यताते । सत्यं तनोतीति ना सत्यं तायते यस्मिन्निति ना सत्यतातिः । हे
> सत्यताते शंसा पापानां शंसितारावुभावासन्नविप्रकृष्टौ शत्रू सूदय ।

> जहि । अनुष्टुयानुक्रमेण कृणुहि । अस्मिन्सूक्ते प्रतिपादितमर्थं कुरु ॥ सधन्यः । धनमेषामस्तीति छंदसीवनपावितीप्रत्ययः । एरनेकाच इति यण् । उदात्तस्वरितयोरिति स्वरितत्वं । अनुष्टुया । अपदुःसुषु । स्थ इति विधीयमानः कुप्रत्ययो बहुलवचनादनुपूर्वस्यापि भवति । सुपांसुलुगिति तृतीयाया याजादेशः। अह्रयाण । ह्री लच्चायां । बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुभावाभावः । अनित्यमागमशासनमिति मुगभावः ॥

> *aprayāṇa alajjitagamana | aprayāṇo 'hrītayāna iti yāskaḥ | tādṛśa he agne vayaṃ stotārastvayā*
> *sadhanyasvaprasādātsamānadhanāstotāstvayā*
> *rakṣitā vayaṃ tava praṇītī praṇītyā tava preraṇenānujñayā vājānannānyaśyāma |*
> *prāpnuyāma | he satyatāte | satyaṃ tanotīti nā satyaṃ tāyate yasminniti nā satyatātiḥ | he satyatāte śaṃsā pāpānāṃ*
> *śaṃsitārāvubhāvāsannaviprakṛṣṭau śatrū sūdaya |*
> *jahi | anuṣṭuyānukrameṇa kṛṇuhi | asminsūkte pratipāditamarthaṃ kuru ‖ sadhanyaḥ |*
> *dhanameṣāmastīti chaṃdasīvanapāvitīpratyayaḥ | eranekāca iti yaṇ | udāttasvaritayoriti svaritatvaṃ | anuṣṭuyā | apaduḥsuṣu | stha iti vidhīyamānaḥ kupratyayo*
> *bahulavacanādanupūrvasyāpi bhavati | supāṃsulugiti tṛtīyāyā yājādeśaḥ| ahrayāṇa | hrī laccāyāṃ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ ślubhāvābhāvaḥ | anityamāgamaśāsanamiti mugabhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

"Apraṇa" (ahrayāṇa) means of unashamed going; "अप्रयाणोऽह्रीतयान इति यास्कः (*aprayāṇo 'hrītayāna iti yāskaḥ*)" (so Yāska). O such Agni, we, the praisers, being "sadhanya," that is, possessed of equal wealth through your favour, protected by you, may through your guidance (प्रणीती (*praṇītī*)), your impulse and leave, attain वाजान् (*vājān*), foods. O सत्यताते (*satyatāte*): one who extends truth, or one in whom truth is extended. O Satyatāti, destroy the two enemies, near and far, who are the utterers (calumniators) of evils. अनुष्टुया (*anuṣṭuyā*): in due order, do कृणुहि (*kṛṇuhi*), that is, accomplish what has been set forth in this hymn.

Word-to-word meaning

- अह्रयाण (*ahrayāṇa*)—O Agni, of unhesitating going

- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we, the praisers
- त्वया (*tvayā*)—by your favour
- सधन्यः (*sadhanyaḥ*)—possessed of excellent wealth
- त्वोताः (*tvotāḥ*)—protected by you
- तव (*tava*)—your
- प्रणीती (*praṇītī*)—by favour
- वाजान् (*vājān*)—horses[?395]
- आश्याम (*āśyāma*)—we obtain
- सत्यताते (*satyatāte*)—O Agni, who increase truth
- शंसा (*śaṃsā*)—desiring sin
- उभा (*ubhā*)—both kinds of enemies, the distant and the near
- सूदय (*sūdaya*)—destroy
- अनुष्टुया (*anuṣṭuyā*)—in order
- तृणुहि (*tṛṇuhi*)—fulfil the purpose of our prayer

Gist

O Agni, of unhesitating going, we the praisers, possessed through your favour of excellent wealth and protected by you, obtain horses through your favour. O Agni, who increase truth, whether the enemies who wish us treachery are far away or nearby, destroy them; and fulfil the purpose of our prayer.

English translation

Agni, you are freed from shame, by you we are made opulent ; by you we are protected ; may we, through your guidance, attain abundant food: cherisher of truth, destroy both (sorts of calumniators), those who are nigh, those who are far off, and in due course fulfil (our desires).

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒या तें॑ अग्ने स॒मिधा॑ विधेम॒ प्रति॒ स्तोमं॑ श॒स्यमा॑नं गृभाय ।
दहा॒शसों॑ र॒क्षसं॑ः पा॒ह्य१॒॑स्मान्द्रु॒हो नि॒दो मिं॑त्रमहो अव॒द्यात् ॥ १५ ॥

> *ayā te agne samidhā vidhema prati stomaṃ śasyamānaṃ gṛbhāya |*
> *dahāśaso rakṣasaḥ pāhyasmāndruho nido mitramaho avadyāt ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अया । ते । अग्ने । संइधा । विधेम । प्रति । स्तोमं । शस्यमानं । गृभाय ।
> दह । अशसः । रक्षसः । पाहि । अस्मान् । द्रुहः । निदः । मित्रमहः । अवद्यात् ॥१५॥

> *ayā | te | agne | saṃidhā | vidhema | prati | stomaṃ | śasyamānaṃ | gṛbhāya |*
> *daha | aśasaḥ | rakṣasaḥ | pāhi | asmān | druhaḥ | nidaḥ | mitramahaḥ | avadyāt ‖15‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने अयानया समिधा दीप्या स्तुत्या ते त्वां विधेम । परिचरेम ।
> अस्माभिः शस्यमानमिमं स्तोमं स्तोत्रं प्रति गृभाय । प्रतिगृहाण । अशसः ।
> शंसंति स्तुवंतीति शसः स्तोतारः । ते न भवंतीत्यशसो नृशंसाः । तान्रक्षसो दह ।

> *he agne ayānayā samidhā dīpyā stutyā te tvāṃ vidhema | paricarema |*
> *asmābhiḥ śasyamānamimaṃ stomaṃ stotraṃ prati gṛbhāya |*
> *pratigṛhāṇa | aśasaḥ |*
> *śaṃsaṃti stuvaṃtīti śasaḥ stotāraḥ | te na bhavaṃtītyaśaso nṛśaṃsāḥ |*
> *tānrakṣaso daha |*

> भस्मसात्कुरु । हे मित्रमहो मित्रैः पूजनीय हे अग्ने द्रुहो द्रोग्धुर्निदो
> निंदकादवद्यात्परिवावाद्यास्मान् पाहि । रक्ष ॥ गृभाये । ग्रहेर्लोटि छंदसि शायजपीति श्नः
> शायच् । हृग्रहोर्भः । पाहि । वाक्यभेदादनिघातः । निदः । णिदि कुत्सायां । क्विप् ।

> आगमशासनस्यानित्यत्वान्नुमभावः । सावेकाच इति विभक्तेरुदात्तत्वं ।
> अवद्यात् । अवद्यपण्येति यत् । ययतोश्चातदर्थे । पा, ६-२-१५६ । इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं ।
> मित्रमहो अवद्यादित्यत्र संहितायामव्यादवद्यादित्येजः प्रकृतिभावः ॥

> *bhasmasātkuru | he mitramaho mitraiḥ pūjanīya he agne druho*
> *drogdhurnido*
> *niṃdakādavadyātparivāvāccāsmān pāhi | rakṣa ‖ gṛbhāyè | graherloṭi*
> *chaṃdasi śāyajapīti śnaḥ śāyac | hṛgrahorbhaḥ | pāhi |*
> *vākyabhedādanighātaḥ | nidaḥ | ṇidi kutsāyāṃ | kvip |*
> *āgamaśāsanasyānityatvānnumabhāvaḥ | sāvekāca iti*
> *vibhakterudāttatvaṃ |*
> *avadyāt | avadyapaṇyeti yat | yayatoścātadarthe | pā, 6-2-156 |*
> *ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ | mitramaho avadyādityatra*
> *saṃhitāyāmavyādavadyādityejaḥ prakṛtibhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, with this समिधा (*samidhā*), this shining praise, we serve you. Accept (गृभाय (*gṛbhāya*), take) this hymn of praise recited by us. अशसः (*aśasaḥ*): those who praise are "śasaḥ," praisers; those who are not such are "aśasaḥ," ill-speakers. Burn those rākṣasas.

Reduce them to ashes. O मित्रमहो (*mitramaho*), worthy of worship by friends, O Agni, protect us from the oppressor (द्रुहः (*druhaḥ*)), from the reviler (निदः (*nidaḥ*)), from blame (अवद्यात् (*avadyāt*)), that is, from reproach.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अया समिधा (*ayā samidhā*)—by this shining praise
- ते (*te*)—you
- विधेम (*vidhema*)—we serve
- शस्यमानं (*śasyamānaṃ*)—recited by us
- इमं स्तोमं (*imaṃ stomaṃ*)—this hymn of praise
- प्रति गृभाय (*prati gṛbhāya*)—accept
- अशसः (*aśasaḥ*)—who do not praise you
- रक्षसः (*rakṣasaḥ*)—the rākṣasas
- दह (*daha*)—burn

- मित्रमहः (*mitramahaḥ*)—O Agni, worthy of worship by friends
- द्रुहः (*druhaḥ*)—of the treacherous one
- निदः (*nidaḥ*)—reviling
- अवद्यात् (*avadyāt*)—from reproach
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us
- पाहि (*pāhi*)—protect

Gist

O Agni, we serve you with this shining praise. Accept this hymn of praise recited by us. Burn the rākṣasas who do not praise you. O Agni, worthy of worship by friends, protect us from the reviling reproach of the treacherous one.

English translation

May we propitiate you, Agni, by this fuel : accept the praise that is recited by us : consume the unadoring Rakshasas ; you who are to be honour- ed by (your) friends, preserve us from the reproach of the oppressor and the reviler.

Special Topics

अया (*ayā*)—अनया (*anayā*). For the convenience of the metre, the middle letter, the na, of the word अनया (*anayā*) has been dropped, giving अया (*ayā*). Or else it appears that in that period both the word अनया (*anayā*) and the word अया (*ayā*) were current. For the use of the word अया (*ayā*) in place of अनया (*anayā*) is frequent in the Ṛgveda. For example:

चोदः कुवित्तु तुज्यात्सातये धियः शुचिप्रतीकं तमया धिया गृणे ॥ (*codaḥ kuvittu tujyātsātaye dhiyaḥ śucipratīkaṃ tamayā dhiyā gṛṇe ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-143-6)

… the Ṛg-Veda also appears to have both forms current. For the use of the word आया (*āyā*) in place of अया (*ayā*) is frequent in the Ṛg-Veda. For example:

अया धिया मनवे श्रुष्टिमाव्या साकं नरो दंसनैरा चिकित्सेरे । (*ayā dhiyā manave śruṣṭimāvyā sākaṃ naro daṃsanairā cikitsère |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-166-13)

अयो ते अग्ने विधेमोर्जो नपादश्वमिष्टे । एना सूक्तेन सुजात ॥ (*ayo te agne vidhemorjo napādaśvamiṣṭe | enā sūktena sujāta ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-6-2)

In the word आया (*āyā*) in these Ṛks the letter n has been elided. In the same way, dropping the letter आ (*ā*) of the word आत्मना (*ātmanā*) and using it as त्मना (*tmanā*) is also current in the Ṛg-Veda.

समिधा (*samidhā*)—The word समित् (*samit*) ordinarily means something that blazes well, that is burning. In this same sense the word is also used for the dried sticks of certain trees employed for the oblation. But here the Bhāṣyakāra has given the meaning "by a praise that makes the qualities of Agni manifest". In this Ṛk there is room for both meanings, fuel-stick and praise.

अशसः (*aśasaḥ*)—शंसंति स्तुवंतीति शसः स्तोतारः । ते न भवंतीत्यशसो नृशंसाः । (*śaṃsaṃti stuvaṃtīti śasaḥ stotāraḥ | te na bhavaṃtītyaśaso nṛśaṃsāḥ |*). The Bhāṣyakāra's explanation is that people who praise the gods are called शसः (*śasaḥ*), and wicked people who do not praise are called अशसः (*aśasaḥ*).

The concluding verses of the Bhāṣya and the colophon (Sanskrit, not translated in the Kannada): वेदार्थस्य प्रकाशेन तमो हार्दं निवारयन् । पुमर्थांश्च तुरो देयाद्विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरः ॥ (*vedārthasya prakāśena tamo hārdaṃ nivārayan | pumarthāṃśca turo deyādvidyātīrthamaheśvaraḥ* ‖) इति श्रीमद्राजाधिराजपरमेश्वरवैदिकमार्गप्रवर्तक श्रीवीरबुक्कभूपालसाम्राज्यधुरंधरेण, सायणाचार्येण विरचिते माधवीये वेदार्थप्रकाशे ऋक्संहिताभाष्ये तृतीयाष्टके चतुर्थोऽध्यायः समाप्तः ॥ (*iti śrīmadrājādhirājaparameśvaravaidikamārgapravartaka śrīvīrabukkabhūpālasāmrājyadhuraṃdhareṇa, sāyaṇācāryeṇa viracite mādhavīye vedārthaprakāśe ṛksaṃhitābhāṣye tṛtīyāṣṭake caturtho 'dhyāyaḥ samāptaḥ* ‖) ओं तत्सत् (*oṃ tatsat*)

Here the fourth adhyāya in the third Aṣṭaka of the Ṛg-Veda Saṃhitā, with the Śrī Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya and the Kannada translation, is concluded.

यदक्षरपदभ्रष्टं मात्राहीनं तु यद्भवेत् । तत्सर्वं क्षम्यतां देव वागीश्वर नमोऽस्तु ते ॥ (*yadakṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ tu yadbhavet | tatsarvaṃ kṣamyatāṃ deva vāgīśvara namo 'stu te* ‖) शुभं शुभयात् (*śubhaṃ śubhayāt*) मगळं (*magaḷaṃ*)

ओं (*oṃ*) श्री महागणाधिपतये नमः (*śrī mahāgaṇādhipataye namaḥ*)

वागीशाद्या सुमनसः सर्वार्थानामुपक्रमे यं नत्वा कृतकृत्याः स्युस्तं नमामि गजाननं ॥ (*vāgīśādyā sumanasaḥ sarvārthānāmupakrame yaṃ natvā kṛtakṛtyāḥ syustaṃ namāmi gajānanaṃ* ‖) यस्य निश्यसितं वेदा यो वेदेभ्योखिलं जगत् । निर्ममे तमहं वंदे विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरं ॥ (*yasya niśyasitaṃ vedā yo vedebhyokhilaṃ jagat | nirmame tamahaṃ vaṃde vidyātīrthamaheśvaraṃ* ‖) तृतीयाष्टकमध्यस्थ चतुर्थोऽध्याय आदरात् । व्याख्यातः सायणार्ये ण पंचमो व्याकरिष्यते ॥ (*tṛtīyāṣṭakamadhyastha caturtho 'dhyāya ādarāt | vyākhyātaḥ sāyaṇārye ṇa paṃcamo vyākariṣyate* ‖) वेदः शिवः शिवो वेदो वेदाध्यायी सदाशिवः । तस्मात्सर्वप्रयत्नेन वेदमेव सदा जपेत् ॥ (*vedaḥ śivaḥ śivo vedo vedādhyāyī sadāśivaḥ | tasmātsarvaprayatnena vedameva sadā japet* ‖)

Ṛg-Veda Saṃhitā with the Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya. The fifth adhyāya in the third Aṣṭaka.

Sūkta 5 (Maṇḍala 4)

Hymns of the Fourth Maṇḍala, 5–18. The fifth hymn.

In this hymn Vaiśvānara Agni is praised. Although we have earlier given extensive explanations about Vaiśvānara Agni many times, here we explain, as Yāska has stated them, the matters Yāska has set out at length in the Nirukta, and the differing opinions of other sages.

वैश्वानरः। इति त्रीणि पदानि । वैश्वानरः कस्माद्विश्वान्नरान्नयति । विश्व एनं नरा नयंतीति वा । अपि ना विश्वानर एव स्यात् प्रत्यृतः सर्वाणि भूतानि तस्य वैश्वानरः ॥ (*vaiśvānaraḥ| iti trīṇi padāni | vaiśvānaraḥ kasmādviśvānnarānnayati | viśva enaṃ narā nayaṃtīti vā | api nā viśvānara eva syāt pratyṛtaḥ sarvāṇi bhūtāni tasya vaiśvānaraḥ ॥*) (Ni. 7-21).

Now we shall explain the word वैश्वानर (*vaiśvānara*). This word वैश्वानर (*vaiśvānara*) denotes a deity possessing the meaning of the three words विश्वान् नरान् नयति (*viśvān narān nayati*). Why did Vaiśvānara get this name? This god विश्वान् नरान् नयति (*viśvān narān nayati*)—leads all people along the good path; that is, he is the one who sets all people on the good path; therefore this god is named Vaiśvānara.

Or: विश्व एनं नरा नयंतीति (*viśva enaṃ narā nayaṃtīti*)—all people carry this god in the sacrifices they perform to the northern altar. That is, when performing the rite called Agni-praṇayana in sacrifices, they take Agni, churned and produced at the place of its origin, according to rule to the northern altar and establish it there. Or, all people take Agni to their own houses and establish it in places such as the great kitchen for the work of cooking; therefore this Agni is called Vaiśvānara. Or Viśvānara himself is Vaiśvānara. This Viśvānara pervades the bodies of all creatures, dwells there in the form of the digestive fire and digests the food and the like that creatures eat. Therefore the Viśvānara in the bodies of all creatures is Vaiśvānara Agni.[?396]

वैश्वानरस्य सुमतौ स्याम राजा हिकं भुवनानामभि श्रीः । इतो जातो विश्वमिदं विचष्टे वैश्वानरो यतते सूर्येण ॥ (*vaiśvānarasya sumatau syāma rājā hikaṃ bhuvanānāmabhi śrīḥ | ito jāto viśvamidaṃ vicaṣṭe vaiśvānaro yatate sūryeṇa ॥*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-98-1).

This Ṛk praises Vaiśvānara Agni: may we become worthy of the favourable mind of Vaiśvānara Agni. For this Vaiśvānara Agni is a king, and a king is the support of all worlds. Born in this world, he looks upon the whole universe; together with the sun he pervades everything. This is the main purport of the Ṛk.

Who is Vaiśvānara Agni? Is he a deity of the middle region?

इतो जातः सर्वमिदनुभिविपश्यति वैश्वानरः संयतते सूर्येण राजा यः सर्वेषां भूतानामभिश्रयणीयस्तस्य वयं वैश्वानरस्य कल्याण्यां मत् स्यामेति । तत्को वैश्वानरः । मध्यम इत्याचार्याः ॥ (*ito jātaḥ sarvamidanubhivipaśyati vaiśvānaraḥ saṃyatate sūryeṇa rājā yaḥ sarveṣāṃ bhūtānāmabhiśrayaṇīyastasya vayaṃ vaiśvānarasya kalyāṇyāṃ mat syāmeti | tatko vaiśvānaraḥ | madhyama ityācāryāḥ ॥*) (Ni. 7-22).

This is the explanation of the Ṛk. This Vaiśvānara Agni, born in this very world, is able to see the whole universe; together with the sun he pervades the whole universe. May we become worthy of the best mind, that is, the favour, of such a Vaiśvānara Agni. He is the king and the support of all created beings.

But who is this Vaiśvānara? What is his nature? Some teachers say that Vaiśvānara is a deity dwelling in the middle region (the atmosphere), because their view is that this Vaiśvānara is the cause of rain. Therefore a Ṛk describing the part this Vaiśvānara plays in the rain-rite is cited here:

प्र नू महित्वं वृषभस्य वोचं यं पूरवो वृत्रहणं सचंते । वैश्वानरो दस्युमग्निर्जघन्वा अधूनोत्कृष्टा अन शंबरं भेत् ॥ (*pra nū mahitvaṃ vṛṣabhasya vocaṃ yaṃ pūravo vṛtrahaṇaṃ sacaṃte | vaiśvānaro dasyumagnirjaghanvā adhūnotkṛṣṭā ana śaṃbaraṃ bhet ॥*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-59-6).

I shall describe in particular the greatness of this Vaiśvānara Agni, the giver of what is desired. Many people serve with devotion this Vaiśvānara Agni, the slayer of Vṛtra. This Vaiśvānara Agni destroyed Vṛtra the Dasyu. He split (killed) Śambara (the cloud) and made the waters stored in the clouds fall on the earth as rain. This is the main purport of the Ṛk.

This is Yāska's explanation[?397]:

प्रब्रवीमि तन्महित्वं माहाभाग्यं वृषभस्य वर्षितुरपां यं पूरवः पूरयि तव्या मनुष्या वृत्रहणं मेघहनं सचंते सेवंते वर्षकामाः । दस्युर्दस्यतेः क्षयार्थादुपदस्यंत्यस्मिन्नरसा उपदासयति कर्माणि तमग्निर्वैश्वा नरो घ्नन्नवादूनोदपः काष्ठा अभिनच्छंबरं मेघं ॥ (*prabravīmi tanmahitvaṃ māhābhāgyaṃ vṛṣabhasya varṣiturapāṃ yaṃ pūravaḥ pūrayi tavyā manuṣyā vṛtrahaṇaṃ meghahanaṃ sacaṃte sevaṃte varṣakāmāḥ | dasyurdasyateḥ kṣayārthādupadasyaṃtyasminnrasā upadāsayati karmāṇi tamagnirvaiśvā naro ghnannavādūnodapaḥ kāṣṭhā abhinacchaṃbaraṃ meghaṃ ‖*) (Ni. 7-23).

So it stands. I shall describe in a special manner the great majesty (the surpassing power) of this Vaiśvānara Agni who pours down rain-water. People who desire what they wish for and who long for rain serve with reverence, with praises and the like, this Vaiśvānara Agni who destroys Vṛtra (the cloud). The word दस्यु (*dasyu*), formed from the root दस् (*das*) "to destroy", denotes a wicked one who prevents the water from falling on the earth and ruins it. Vaiśvānara Agni struck such a Dasyu, Śambara (the cloud; the word शंबर (*śaṃbara*) is read among the names of the cloud), scattered the waters collected in the cloud and made them fall on the earth as rain. This is the main purport.

The view of the earlier Yājñikas that Vaiśvānara is Āditya (objections and answers on this point)

अथासावादित्य इति पूर्वे याज्ञिकाः । एषां लोकानां रोहेण सवनानां रोह आम्मातो रोहात् प्रत्यवरोहश्चिकीर्षितस्तामनुकृतिं होताग्नि- मारुते शस्त्रे वैश्वानरीयेण सूक्तेन प्रतिपद्यते सोऽपि न स्तोत्रियमाद्रियेताग्नेयो हि भवति । तत आगच्छति मध्यस्थाना देवता रुद्रं च मरुतश्च ततोऽग्निमिहस्थानमत्रवै स्तोत्रियं शंसति. (*athāsāvāditya iti pūrve yājñikāḥ | eṣāṃ lokānāṃ roheṇa savanānāṃ roha āmmāto rohāt pratyavarohaścikīrṣitastāmanukṛtiṃ hotāgni- mārute śastre vaiśvānarīyeṇa sūktena pratipadyate so 'pi na stotriyamādriyetāgneyo hi bhavati | tata āgacchati madhyasthānā devatā rudraṃ ca marutaśca tato 'gnimihasthānamatravai stotriyaṃ śaṃsati.*) (Ni. 7-23).

Certain earlier teachers, skilled in the performance of sacrifices, say that this Āditya visible to our eyes is Vaiśvānara. They give the reason thus. In sacrificial rites such as the morning pressing there is an order of rohā and avaroha, that is, ascent and descent. In the worlds also it is so: the earth (the lower region), the atmosphere (the middle region), heaven (the celestial region). Likewise in the pressings there are three: the morning pressing, the midday pressing and the third pressing. In sacrifices the Hotṛ at the morning pressing invokes and praises the deities of the earth region, at the midday pressing the deities of the middle region, and at the third pressing the deities of the celestial region (heaven). This is the order of ascent. After the ascent comes the order of descent: first the deities of the celestial region, then those of the middle region, then those of the earth region are praised in order. This is the order of descent. In the order of descent they praise first Vaiśvānara Agni with the hymn वैश्वानराय पृथुपाजसे (*vaiśvānarāya pṛthupājase*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 3-3-1), then the middle-region deities Rudra and the Maruts with the hymn आते पितर्मरुतां (*āte pitarmarutāṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 2-23-1), then Agni, the deity of the earth region, with the hymn यज्ञायज्ञा वो अग्नये (*yajñāyajñā vo agnaye*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-48-1). Since in the order of descent the praise of Vaiśvānara Agni comes first, and since Āditya is a deity of the celestial region, this Vaiśvānara Agni is Āditya. This is their line of argument.

अथापि वैश्वानरीयो द्वादशकपालो भवत्येतस्य हि द्वादशविधं कर्म । (*athāpi vaiśvānarīyo dvādaśakapālo bhavatyetasya hi dvādaśavidhaṃ karma |*).

Moreover, to Vaiśvānara Agni an oblation of twelve potsherds is always offered; and for Āditya also, आदित्यं द्वादशकपालं (*ādityaṃ dvādaśakapālaṃ*), the offering of twelve potsherds is prescribed. Just as for Āditya an offering in twelve parts, indicating the twelve months, is prescribed, so it is for Vaiśvānara Agni; therefore this Vaiśvānara Agni is Āditya.

अथापि ब्राह्मणं भवत्यसौ ना आदित्योऽग्निर्वैश्वानरः ॥ (*athāpi brāhmaṇaṃ bhavatyasau nā ādityo 'gnirvaiśvānaraḥ ‖*).

Moreover, there is also a Brāhmaṇa statement that this Āditya is Vaiśvānara Agni.

अथापि निवित् सौर्यवैश्वानरी भवत्या यो द्यां भात्या पृथिवीमित्येष हि द्यानापृथिव्यानाभासयति ।

(*athāpi nivit sauryavaiśvānarī bhavatyā yo dyāṃ bhātyā pṛthivīmityeṣa hi dyānāpṛthivyānābhāsayati |*)

A nivid mantra is a particular mantra that praises one deity, praising that deity's distinction in the midst of the śastra mantras; it is a separate mantra inserted and recited among the śastra mantras. Here, when the nivid mantras addressed to Āditya are recited, the Saurya-Vaiśvānarī mantra is recited; that is, that nivid mantra praises both the sun and Vaiśvānara Agni (sings the qualities of those deities). That mantra begins आ यो द्यां भात्या प्रथिवीं (*ā yo dyāṃ bhātyā prathivīṃ*) and means "who lights heaven and earth with his own light". The one who lights heaven and earth with his own light is Āditya; therefore Vaiśvānara Agni, as taught in this mantra, is Āditya too.

अथापि छांदोमिकं सूक्तं सौर्यवैश्वानरं भवति दिवि पृष्ठो अरोचत इत्येष हि दिवि पृष्ठो अरोचतेति । (*athāpi chāṃdomikaṃ sūktaṃ sauryavaiśvānaraṃ bhavati divi pṛṣṭho arocata ityeṣa hi divi pṛṣṭho arocateti |*).

And the Chāndomika hymn दिवि पृष्ठो अरोचत (*divi pṛṣṭho arocata*) (Vā. Saṃ. 33-92) has the sun-and-Vaiśvānara as its deity. In it it is said that he shines on the back (the lower part) of heaven. One who shines in heaven is Āditya. Since Vaiśvānara is praised in this very hymn, this Vaiśvānara Agni is Āditya.

अथापि हविष्वांतीयं सूक्तं सौर्यवैश्वानरं भवति (*athāpi haviṣvāṃtīyaṃ sūktaṃ sauryavaiśvānaraṃ bhavati*).

And the hymn हविष्वांतमजरं (*haviṣvāṃtamajaraṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-1), called Haviṣvantīya (the hymn recited at the time of drinking the oblation), has the sun and Vaiśvānara Agni as its deities; that is, this hymn is addressed to Saurya-Vaiśvānara Agni. In the Ṛk of this hymn

विश्वस्था अग्निं भुवनाय देवा वैश्वानरं केतुमह्नामकृण्वन् । (*viśvasthā agniṃ bhuvanāya devā vaiśvānaraṃ ketumahnāmakṛṇvan |*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-2)

it is said that the gods appointed this Vaiśvānara Agni to produce the ahas (days, daytimes), in order to give light to the whole world. Since it is the sun who produces the days, and since this Vaiśvānara Agni too has the power to produce days, Vaiśvānara Agni and Āditya are one person; that is, this Vaiśvānara Agni is Āditya. All this is the view of the earlier teachers, the Yājñikas.

The view of Śākapūṇi that Vaiśvānara is the earthly Agni (not Āditya) (objections and answers on this point)

अयमेवाग्निर्वैश्वानर इति शाकपूणिः । विश्वानरावेते उत्तरे ज्योतिषी वैश्वानरोऽयं यत्ताभ्यां जायते । कथं नृयमेताभ्यां जायत इति यत्र वैद्युतः शरणमभिहंति यावदनुपात्तो भवति मध्यमधर्मैव तावद्भवत्युदकेंधनः शरीरोपशमन उपादीयमान एवायं संपद्यत उदकोपशमनः शरीरदीप्तिः ॥ (*ayamevāgnirvaiśvānara iti śākapūṇiḥ | viśvānarāvete uttare jyotiṣī vaiśvānaro 'yaṃ yattābhyāṃ jāyate | kathaṃ nṛyametābhyāṃ jāyata iti yatra vaidyutaḥ śaraṇamabhihaṃti yāvadanupātto bhavati madhyamadharmaiva tāvadbhavatyudakeṃdhanaḥ śarīropaśamana upādīyamāna evāyaṃ saṃpadyata udakopaśamanaḥ śarīradīptiḥ ‖*)

The view of the teacher called Śākapūṇi is that this earthly Agni is Vaiśvānara Agni. For the earthly Agni arises from two lights (viśvānara fires): the light of Āditya in the celestial region and the lightning light in the middle region. Therefore the fire born of the viśvānara fires is called Vaiśvānara Agni; that is, the earthly Agni is Vaiśvānara Agni. How the earthly Agni arises from the two lights, the light of Āditya and the light of lightning, they now explain. The light of Āditya, which undergoes no change in place or nature, is called the first quality. That is, this light of Āditya, staying where it is, draws up by its rays the waters of oceans and other reservoirs and turns those waters into clouds. This is the work of the first light. Next the lightning fire is called the second. The nature of this lightning fire is the "middle quality", that is, different. This lightning fire has the nature of moving in the midst of the waters (the clouds) and of striking and destroying trees, houses and the like on which people depend; that is, because this lightning fire is able to move in water, it cannot be quenched by water (as ordinary fire is quenched). And ordinary fire, kindled by trees, wood and the like, begins to blaze; but when the lightning fire touches trees and the like, it is quenched there itself, that is, its force ends right there; it does not grow from trees and the like. And this lightning fire cannot be held with the hands and the like. This is the nature of the lightning fire. But the nature of the earthly (ordinary) fire is quite the opposite: the earthly fire can be increased by wood and the like, quenched by water, and held with the hands. These are the natural qualities of the earthly fire.

An explanation is necessary on how the earthly Agni arises from the two lights, that of the celestial region and that of the middle region. Āditya, the light of the celestial region, attracts by his rays the waters of oceans and other reservoirs and turns them into clouds; when the lightning fire that appears in those clouds touches trees and the like, the earthly fire arises and burns. This is well known in the world. Therefore it is explained here that the earthly Agni arises from both lights, that of the celestial region and that of the middle region. Hence the earthly Agni, born of the two lights that are viśvānara fires, is called Vaiśvānara Agni.

अथादित्यादुदीचीप्रथमसमावृत्त आदित्ये कंसं वा मणिं वा परिमृज्य प्रतिस्वरे यत्र शुष्कगोमयमसंस्पर्शयन् धारयति यत् प्रदीप्यते सोऽयमेव संपद्यते ।

(*athādityādudīcīprathamasamāvṛtta āditye kaṃsaṃ vā maṇiṃ vā parimṛjya pratisvare yatra śuṣkagomayamasaṃsparśayan dhārayati yat pradīpyate so 'yameva saṃpadyate |*)

They give another example of the earthly fire arising from Āditya. When the sun has come in the atmosphere facing the northern direction, that is, at midday, when he is very hot, if one holds a well-shining copper plate or a mirror facing the sun and makes its rays converge (gather together) and fall on a powder of dry cow-dung placed on the ground, fire at once catches. This too is an example showing that the earthly fire arises from Āditya.

अथाप्याह—वैश्वानरो यतते सूर्येण—न च पुनरात्मनात्मा संयततेऽन्येन्नैवान्यः संयतत इति इममादधात्यमुतोऽमुष्य रश्मयः प्रादुर्भवंतीतोऽस्यार्चिषस्तयोर्भासोः संसंगं दृष्ट्वावमवक्ष्यत् ।

(*athāpyāha—vaiśvānaro yatate sūryeṇa—na ca punarātmanātmā saṃyatate 'nyennaivānyaḥ saṃyatata iti imamādadhātyamuto 'muṣya raśmayaḥ prādurbhavaṃtīto 'syārciṣastayorbhāsoḥ saṃsaṃgaṃ dṛṣṭvāvamavakṣyat |*)

In the example given before, in the sentence वैश्वानरो यतते सूर्येण (*vaiśvānaro yatate sūryeṇa*), the seer, the beholder of the mantra, has said that Vaiśvānara Agni, joined with the sun, spreads, that is, pervades everything. Since the sun's position does not change, it is impossible that the sun goes forward from his place with Vaiśvānara Agni and pervades. A thing can be in one place at one time, but it cannot be there and also go forward. Only if another thing joins it can it pervade another place. Therefore here the sun is one and Vaiśvānara Agni another; the two together are able to pervade everything. Here the earthly fire is kindled right here (on the earth). The light of Āditya, setting out from the celestial world by way of the rays, meets the earthly fire on the earth. That is, the light of the sun and the light of Agni join as one and that light spreads everywhere by the rays; it is with this thought in mind that the seer, the beholder of the mantra, spoke the sentence वैश्वानरो यतते सूर्येण (*vaiśvānaro yatate sūryeṇa*).

अथ यान्येतान्यौत्तमिकानि सूक्तानि भागानि ना सावित्राणि ना सौर्याणि वा पौष्णानि वा वैष्णवानि वा वैश्वदेन्यानि वा तेषु वैश्वानरीयाः प्रवादा अभविष्यन्नादित्यकर्मणा जैनमस्तोष्यन्नित्युदेषीत्यस्तमेषीति विपर्येषीति ॥ आ (*atha yānyetānyauttamikāni sūktāni bhāgāni nā sāvitrāṇi nā sauryāṇi vā pauṣṇāni vā vaiṣṇavāni vā vaiśvadenyāni vā teṣu vaiśvānarīyāḥ pravādā abhaviṣyannādityakarmaṇā jainamastoṣyannityudeṣītyastameṣīti viparyeṣīti ‖ ā*) आग्नेयेष्टेव हि सूक्तेषु वैश्वानरीयाः प्रवादा भवंति । अग्निकर्माणा चैनं स्तौतीति वहसीति पचसीति दहसीति ॥ (*āgneyeṣṭeva hi sūkteṣu vaiśvānarīyāḥ pravādā bhavaṃti | agnikarmāṇā cainaṃ stautīti vahasīti pacasīti dahasīti ‖*)

If Vaiselvānara were Āditya, then in the hymns or Ṛks relating to Āditya or Savitṛ, or in the hymns in which Sūrya, Pūṣan, Viṣṇu or the Viśve-devas are the subjects, the qualities and distinctions pertaining to Āditya would be attributed to Vaiśvānara Agni, that is (as is said of the sun) "you rise, you set, you travel in the atmosphere", and so on in the sense ...

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

...they ought to have been praised by signifying sentences and the like. But it is not so. Only in the hymns that concern Agni are the sentences describing Agni's qualities and functions, such as carrying the oblation, cooking and burning, said in a way that applies also to

Vaiśvānara-Agni. That is, Agni's own qualities are applied to Vaiśvānara-Agni and described. Therefore Vaiśvānara-Agni is the terrestrial fire and not Āditya.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यथो एतद्वर्षकर्मणा ह्येनं स्तोतीत्यस्मिन्नप्येतदुपपद्यते ।
> समानमेतदुदकमुच्चैत्यव चाहभिः ।
> भूमिं पर्जन्या जिन्वंति दिवं जिन्वंत्यग्नयः ॥

> *yatho etadvarṣakarmaṇā hyenaṃ stotītyasminnapyetadupapadyate |*
> *samānametadudakamuccaityava cāhabhiḥ |*
> *bhūmiṃ parjanyā jinvaṃti divaṃ jinvaṃtyagnayaḥ ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska says that this, too, holds in the case of the one who is praised through the rain-action (the rain-work). The water is common to both: it goes up and, by the days, comes down again (े । समानमेतदुदकमुच्चैत्यव चाहभिः । भूमिं पर्जन्या जिन्वंति दिवं जिन्वंत्यग्नयः ॥ (*e | samānametadudakamuccaityava cāhabhiḥ | bhūmiṃ parjanyā jinvaṃti divaṃ jinvaṃtyagnayaḥ ||*)). He then cites the Ṛk: the Parjanyas quicken the earth, the fires quicken heaven. (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-51)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> इति सा निगदव्याख्याता ॥

> *iti sā nigadavyākhyātā ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska says that this Ṛk is "nigada-explained"[?398]. (Ni. 7-23)

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

There are mantras that praise this Vaiśvānara-Agni as the one who impels the rain-action. Since Āditya is the impeller of the rain-action, Vaiśvānara-Agni would also possess Āditya's qualities; so can one not say that Vaiśvānara-Agni is Āditya himself? No, it is not so. As the days come again and again after the night has passed, so the waters come again and again from the earth up to the atmosphere and from the atmosphere to the earth. So the waters and the days have a common property. Therefore the deity Parjanya satisfies the earth with rain-water, and the fires satisfy heaven. How Agni satisfies heaven: the oblations and the like that the sacrificers offer into Agni in the sacrifice take, in subtle form, that is in the form of smoke, a shape fit for the gods, and bring satisfaction to the gods; the gods, being pleased, bring satisfaction to the dwellers of the earth through rain. Moreover, according to the sentence अग्नौ प्रास्ताहुतिः सम्यगादित्यमुपतिष्ठते (*agnau prāstāhutiḥ samyagādityamupatiṣṭhate*), the oblation offered into Agni gladdens Āditya who is in heaven; so Agni satisfies heaven or Āditya. Rain became the means of mutual help from the earth to heaven and from heaven to the earth. For these reasons Agni, or Vaiśvānara-Agni, is praised as the cause of the rain-action; it does not follow clearly from this that Vaiśvānara is Āditya himself. Since the meaning of this Ṛk is clear, no further explanation is needed.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> कृष्णं नियानं हरयः सुपर्णा अपो वसाना दिवमुत्पतंति ।
> त आववृत्रन्तदनादृतस्यादिद्घृतेन पृथिवी व्युद्यते ॥

> *kṛṣṇaṃ niyānaṃ harayaḥ suparṇā apo vasānā divamutpataṃti |*
> *ta āvavṛtrantadanādṛtasyādidbhṛtena pṛthivī vyudyate ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Sāyaṇa cites the Ṛk without a gloss of his own. It says: the bay, fair-winged ones, clothing themselves in the waters, fly up to heaven towards the dark course; they turned back from the seat of ṛta, and then the earth is wetted with ghṛta (water). (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-164-47)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> कृष्णं निरयणं रात्रिरादित्यस्य हरयः सुपर्णा हरणा आदित्यरश्मयस्ते यदामुतोऽर्वांचः पर्यावर्तंते सहस्थानादुदकस्यादित्यादथ धृतेनोदकेन पृथिवी व्युद्यते धृतमित्युदकनाम जिघर्तेः सिंचतिकर्मणः ॥

> *kṛṣṇaṃ nirayaṇaṃ rātrirādityasya harayaḥ suparṇā haraṇā*
> *ādityaraśmayaste yadāmuto 'rvāṃcaḥ paryāvartaṃte*
> *sahasthānādudakasyādityādatha dhṛtenodakena pṛthivī vyudyate*
> *dhṛtamityudakanāma jighartèḥ siṃcatikarmaṇaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska explains the verse. The dark course (niyāna, niraya) is the night of Āditya. The bay, fair-winged ones (hari, suparṇa) are the bearers, the rays of Āditya. When they turn back from there, from the common seat of the water, Āditya, then the earth is wetted with ghṛta, i.e. water. *dhṛtam* is a name of water, from the root जिघर्ति (*jigharti*), which has the sense of sprinkling. (Ni. 7-24)

भावार्थ (Bhāvārtha)

The rays, which carry water and have an excellent motion, cover with water the dark cloud (or the night) of fixed course; that is, joined with water they spread upward towards heaven. Again they return from Āditya, the seat of the water. At once the earth is wetted (soaked) with water. Here niraya·ṇa may be said to mean a course of movement; the ordinary meaning of this word is a path of exit. Āditya has two courses of movement, one dark in colour and one bright. The dark course may be understood as the night or as the southern course (dakṣiṇāyana); or the movement of the southern course may itself be called Āditya's night-movement. Durgācārya wrote the following explanation of the above Nirukta sentence—

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> नियानं निरयणं निर्गतिः (निर्याति) निर्गच्छंत्येतदिति नियानं वर्त्म पंथाः।
> तच्च पुनरेतत् । रात्रि आदित्यस्य । द्वे ह्यस्यायने शुक्लं चोत्तरं कृष्णं च
> दक्षिणं । सा हि दैवीरात्रिरभिप्रेता । ततो ब्रवीति रात्रिरादित्यस्य ज्योतिषः ।
> स एष भगवानादित्यो यदा जगदनुग्रहाय गर्भमुदकमात्मन्याधित्सुरुत्त
> रायणं प्रतिपद्यते तदैते हरयः रसहरणाः सुपर्णास्तस्य रश्मयः
> सर्वस्मादस्माल्लोकादपोवसानाः आत्मन्याच्छादयंतः आददानाः दिवं द्योतनवंतमेतमादित्यं
> प्रत्युत्पतंति ।

> *niyānaṃ nirayaṇaṃ nirgatiḥ (niryāti) nirgacchaṃtyetaditi niyānaṃ vartma paṃthāḥ|*
> *tacca punaretat | rātri ādityasya | dve hyasyāyane śuklaṃ cottaraṃ kṛṣṇaṃ ca*
> *dakṣiṇaṃ | sā hi daivīrātrirabhipretā | tato bravīti rātrirādityasya jyotiṣaḥ |*
> *sa eṣa bhagavānādityo yadā jagadanugrahāya garbhamudakamātmanyādhitsurutta*
> *rāyaṇaṃ pratipadyate tadaite harayaḥ rasaharaṇāḥ suparṇāstasya*
> *raśmayaḥ sarvasmādasmāllokādapovasānāḥ ātmanyācchādayaṃtaḥ*
> *ādadānāḥ divaṃ dyotanavaṃtametamādityaṃ pratyutpataṃti |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Durga says: niyāna is going out; it is the way, the path. That is the night of Āditya. For he has two courses, the bright northern and the dark southern; the southern is the intended divine night; therefore the text says "the night of Āditya's light". When the venerable Āditya, wishing for the good of the world to place the embryo, water, in himself, enters the northern course, then these bay ones, the carriers of sap, the fair-winged, his rays, covering themselves with the waters from this whole world, taking them, fly up towards the shining Āditya. (Nirukta-vyākhyā 7-24)

भावार्थ (Bhāvārtha)

Āditya's course is of two kinds: one belongs to the northern course and the other to the southern. One is called bright and the other dark. Here "night" is a synonym for the dark course. कृष्णं नियानं नियमनं रात्रिः । देवानां हि रात्रिर्दक्षिणायनं । (*kṛṣṇaṃ niyānaṃ niyamanaṃ rātriḥ | devānāṃ hi rātrirdakṣiṇāyanaṃ |*) "In that" means in that rainy season. The night-time of the gods is called the southern course. When Āditya follows the course of the northern course, all his rays spread through the world, gather water from every region, and join Āditya again at the right time of this night. This is the rainy season; in this season the rain pours down in plenty. धृत (*dhṛta*) is a name for water; the word ghṛta is formed from the root जिघर्ति (*jigharti*), "to sprinkle".

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अथापि ब्राह्मणं भवत्यग्निर्वा इतो वृष्टिं समीरयति धामच्छदिति खलु
> भूत्वा वर्षति मरुतः सृष्टां वृष्टिं नयंति ।
> यदा खलु वासानादित्योग्निं रश्मिभिः पर्यावर्ततेऽथ वर्षतीति ।

> *athāpi brāhmaṇaṃ bhavatyagnirvā ito vṛṣṭiṃ samīrayati dhāmacchaditi khalu*
> *bhūtvā varṣati marutaḥ sṛṣṭāṃ vṛṣṭiṃ nayaṃti |*
> *yadā khalu vāsānādityogniṃ raśmibhiḥ paryāvartate 'tha varṣatīti |*

Gist of the bhāṣya

There is also a Brāhmaṇa: Agni sends the rain from here; having become "dhāmacchad" he rains; the Maruts lead the released rain. When Āditya, clothing himself, turns Agni about with his rays, then it rains.[?399]

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यथो एतद्रोहात् प्रत्यवरोहश्तिकीर्षित इत्याम्नायवचनादेतद्भवति ।
> यथो एतद्वैश्वानरीयो द्वादशकपालो भवतीत्यनिर्वचनं कपालानि भवंत्यस्ति हि सौर्य एककपालः पंचकपालश्च ।
> यथो एतद्ब्राह्मणं भवतीति–बहुभक्तिवादीनि हि ब्राह्मणानि भवंति–पृथिवी
> वैश्वानरः संवत्सरो वैश्वानरो ब्राह्मणो वैश्वानर इति ॥

> *yatho etadrohāt pratyavarohaśtikīrṣita ityāmnāyavacanādetadbhavati |*
> *yatho etadvaiśvānarīyo dvādaśakapālo bhavatītyanirvacanaṃ kapālāni bhavaṃtyasti hi saurya ekakapālaḥ paṃcakapālaśca |*
> *yatho etadbrāhmaṇaṃ bhavatīti-bahubhaktivādīni hi brāhmaṇāni bhavaṃti-pṛthivī*
> *vaiśvānaraḥ saṃvatsaro vaiśvānaro brāhmaṇo vaiśvānara iti ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Sāyaṇa (Yāska) adds that this also follows from the Āmnāya statement about ascent and descent[?400]. The statement that the Vaiśvānarīya has twelve potsherds is no explanation; potsherds belong to the offering, and there is also a Saurya offering with one potsherd and one with five. And as to the Brāhmaṇa statement:

Brāhmaṇas speak with many figurative ascriptions; "the earth is Vaiśvānara, the year is Vaiśvānara, the Brāhmaṇa is Vaiśvānara". (Ni. 7-24)

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

Besides this, many Brāhmaṇa sentences also support this meaning. For example, there is the Brāhmaṇa sentence "Agni sends the rain from this world": अग्नेवै धूमो जायते, धूमादभ्रं, अभ्रात् वृष्टिरिति ह विज्ञायते (*agnevai dhūmo jāyate, dhūmādabhraṃ, abhrāt vṛṣṭiriti ha vijñāyate*)—smoke arises from Agni; from the smoke the cloud and from the cloud the rain; so it is to be understood. Or, when this Āditya makes Agni turn back with his rays, rain comes. Or, by the order of ascent and descent, that is, the oblation offered into Agni reaches, as subtle smoke, the gods in heaven, they are satisfied, and from that the rain-action comes about: for saying this there is no other support than the Brāhmaṇa sentence. The statement that the offering for Vaiśvānara-Agni is of twelve potsherds and that for Sūrya of one potsherd or five is not connected with this matter; it belongs only to the acts that are parts of the sacrifice. In some other Brāhmaṇa sentences, पृथिवी वैश्वानरः (*pṛthivī vaiśvānaraḥ*) and so on, it is said that the earth is Vaiśvānara, the year is Vaiśvānara, the Brāhmaṇa is Vaiśvānara; that is right. But in this context it does not mean that the deities such as the earth are Vaiśvānara-Agni; these are praising sentences, spoken to describe Vaiśvānara's qualities, saying that Vaiśvānara has the qualities of deities such as the earth.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यथो एतन्निवित्सौर्यवैश्वानरी भवतीत्यस्यैव सा भवति—यो विड्भो
> मानुषीभ्यो दीदेत्–इत्येष हि विड्भो मानुषीभ्यो दीप्यते ।
> यथो एतच्छांदोमिकं सूक्तं सौर्यवैश्वानरं भवतीत्यस्यैवैतद्भवति
> जमदग्निभिराहुत इति। जमदग्नयः प्रजमिताग्नयो वा प्रज्वलिताग्नयो ना
> तैरभिहुतो भवति ॥

> *yatho etannivitsauryavaiśvānarī bhavatītyasyaiva sā bhavati—yo viḍbho*
> *mānuṣībhyo dīdet-ityeṣa hi viḍbho mānuṣībhyo dīpyate |*
> *yatho etacchāṃdomikaṃ sūktaṃ sauryavaiśvānaraṃ*
> *bhavatītyasyaivaitadbhavati*

> *jamadagnibhirāhuta iti| jamadagnayaḥ prajamitāgnayo vā*
> *prajvalitāgnayo nā*
> *tairabhihuto bhavati ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The Saurya-Vaiśvānarī nivid belongs to him (Agni): "he who shines for the human clans"; for he shines for the human clans. And the Chandomika hymn that is Saurya-Vaiśvānara, "invoked by the Jamadagnis", also belongs to him. The Jamadagnis are kindled fires, or blazing fires; by them he is invoked[?401]. (Ni. 7-24)

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

There is a nivid-hymn that praises Sūrya and Vaiśvānara. This hymn is recited in the Āgnimāruta-śastra.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अग्निर्वैश्वानरः सोमस्य मत्सत् । विश्वेषां देवानां समित् । अजस्रं दैवं
> ज्योतिः । यो विड्भ्यो मानुषीभ्यो दीदेत् । द्युषु पूर्वासु दिद्युतानः । अजर उषसामनीके । आ
> यो द्यां भात्या पृथिवीं । और्वमुत–

> *agnirvaiśvānaraḥ somasya matsat | viśveṣāṃ devānāṃ samit | ajasraṃ daivaṃ*
> *jyotiḥ | yo viḍbhyo mānuṣībhyo dīdet | dyuṣu pūrvāsu didyutānaḥ | ajara uṣasāmanīke | ā yo dyāṃ bhātyā pṛthivīṃ | aurvamuta-*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The text of the hymn begins: Agni Vaiśvānara, may he rejoice in the Soma; the sāmidhenī of all the gods; unceasing divine light; he who shines for the human clans; shining in the former days; ageless at the front of the dawns; who shines upon heaven and earth… (continued on the next page).

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> रिक्षं । ज्योतिषा यज्ञाय शर्म संयत् । अग्निर्वैश्वानर इह श्रवदिह
> सोमस्य मत्सत् । प्रेमां देवो देवहूतिमवतु देव्या धिया । प्रेदं
> ब्रह्म प्रेदं क्षत्रं । प्रेमं सुन्वंतं यजमानमवतु । चित्रश्चित्ताभिरूतिभिः।
> श्रवद्ब्रह्मण्यवसागमत् ॥

> *rikṣaṃ | jyotiṣā yajñāya śarma saṃyat | agnirvaiśvānara iha śravadiha somasya matsat | premāṃ devo devahūtimavatu devyā dhiyā | predaṃ brahma predaṃ kṣatraṃ | premaṃ sunvaṃtaṃ yajamānamavatu | citraścittābhirūtibhiḥ|*
> *śravadbrahmaṇyavasāgamat* ||

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn continues: the wide atmosphere; with his light he gives shelter to the sacrifice; may Agni Vaiśvānara hear here and rejoice in the Soma; may the god favour this invocation of the gods with his divine thought; this prayer, this lordly power; may he favour the sacrificer who presses the Soma; wondrous with wondrous helps, may he come hearing the prayer with his aid.

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

This hymn is recited in the Āgnimāruta-śastra addressed to Vaiśvānara-Agni. In the middle of this mantra there is the sentence यो विड्भो मानुषीभ्यो दीदेत् (*yo viḍbho mānuṣībhyo dīdet*). Some may say: the one who shines for the benefit of human subjects is Sūrya, so here Sūrya himself is addressed by the word Vaiśvānara, and there is no difference between Sūrya and Vaiśvānara-Agni. Not so. This mantra is recited addressed to Agni. The meaning that the terrestrial fire on the sacrificial altar shines for the benefit of the sacrificers and other people also fits this mantra. Therefore it should be said that Vaiśvānara-Agni is not Sūrya but the terrestrial fire. Besides, in the Chandomika sacrifice called Daśarātra the Saurya-Vaiśvānara hymn जमदग्निभिराहुतः (*jamadagnibhirāhutaḥ*) is recited. This hymn also does not belong to Sūrya; it applies to Agni. For the word jamadagni means a fire well kindled and blazing. In sacrifices and the like, when offering into Agni, it is the custom to make Agni blaze with fuel, ghee and other substances and to make the offerings into that well-burning Agni itself. So the meaning is that this points to the terrestrial fire and not to Āditya (or Sūrya).

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यथो एतद्धविष्वांतीयं सूक्तं सौर्यवैश्वानरं भवतीत्यस्यैव तद्भवति ।
> हविष्वांतमजरं स्वर्विदि दिविस्सृश्याहुतं जुष्टमग्नौ ।
> तस्य भर्मणे भुवनाय देवा धर्मणे कं स्वधया पप्रथंत ॥

> *yatho etaddhaviṣvāṃtīyaṃ sūktaṃ sauryavaiśvānaraṃ bhavatītyasyaiva tadbhavati |*
> *haviṣvāṃtamajaraṃ svarvidi divissṛśyāhutaṃ juṣṭamagnau |*
> *tasya bharmaṇe bhuvanāya devā dharmaṇe kaṃ svadhayā paprathaṃta ॥*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn beginning हविष्वांतमजरं (*haviṣvāṃtamajaraṃ*) (Haviṣvāntīya), the Saurya-Vaiśvānara hymn, also belongs to him (Agni). The verse says: the oblation, ageless, knowing heaven (svarvid), touching heaven, offered, welcome in Agni; for the bearing, becoming and holding of the world the gods, with svadhā, spread it out. (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-1)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> हविर्यत्सानीयमजरं सूर्यविदि दिविस्पृश्यभिहुतं जुष्टमग्नौ तस्य
> भरणाय च भावनाय च धारणाय च चैतेभ्यः सर्वेभ्यः कर्मभ
> इममग्निमन्नेनापप्रथंतेति.

> *haviryatsānīyamajaraṃ sūryavidi divispṛśyabhihutaṃ juṣṭamagnau tasya*
> *bharaṇāya ca bhāvanāya ca dhāraṇāya ca caitebhyaḥ sarvebhyaḥ karmabha*
> *imamagnimannenāpaprathaṃteti.*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska explains: the oblation that is ageless, सूर्यविदि (*sūryavidi*), touching heaven, offered into Agni and welcomed; for the bearing, becoming and holding, for all these acts, the gods increase this Agni with food. (Ni. 7-25)

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

Moreover, the hymn हविष्वांतमजरं (*haviṣvāṃtamajaraṃ*) has the Saurya-Vaiśvānara-Agni as deity. If it is said that the Vaiśvānara praised in this hymn is Āditya, that is not right. The Vaiśvānara-Agni spoken of there is the terrestrial fire. This becomes clear if the meaning is examined: this oblation, ageless, that is imperishable, and pleasing, is offered, before it is drunk, into this Agni who touches heaven with his light and knows the sun well.

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

The gods, for the bearing, holding, becoming and other acts of that oblation, join food with it and make it grow; this is the main sense of the Ṛk. Before drinking the oblation spoken of in this hymn or Ṛk, they offer it into Agni. This oblation is imperishable and pleasant to the mind (for drinking). They offer it into the sacrificial fire that touches the sky (heaven) with its flames, that is, that is well kindled and is aware of the sun. In order that this oblation may have the powers of holding, nourishing, bearing, becoming and so on, the gods add food to it and make it increase. Since the offering of the oblation is spoken of here, the offering belongs to Agni, that is to the terrestrial fire, not to Sūrya. They offer into Agni and not into Sūrya. Therefore the deity Vaiśvānara set forth in this hymn is not Āditya or Sūrya; it must be said that it is the terrestrial fire.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अथाप्याह——
> अपामुपस्थे महिषा अगृभ्यत विशो राजानमुप तस्थु र्ऋग्मीयं ।
> आ दूतो अग्निरभरद्विवस्वतो वैश्वानरं मातरिश्वा परावतः ॥

> *athāpyāha—*
> *apāmupasthe mahiṣā agṛbhyata viśo rājānamupa tasthu rṛgmīyaṃ |*
> *ā dūto agnirabharadvivasvato vaiśvānaraṃ mātariśvā parāvataḥ ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

He says further: in the lap of the waters the great ones were seized; the clans waited upon the king, the worthy of praise; the messenger Agni brought Vaiśvānara from afar, from Vivasvat; Mātariśvan. (Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-8-4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अपामुपस्थ उपस्थाने महत्यंतरिक्षलोक आसीना महांत इति वागृह्णत
> माध्यमिका देवगणा विश इव राजानमुपतस्थु र्यग्नियमृग्यंतमिति
> वार्चनीयमिति ना पूजनीयमिति वाहरद्यं दूतो देवानां विवस्वत
> आदित्याद्वि वस्वाद्विवासनवान् प्रेरितवतः परागताद्वापि वास्याग्नेर्वैश्वानरस्य
> मातरिश्वानमाहर्तारमाड ॥
> मातरिश्वा वायुर्मा तर्यंतरिक्षे श्वसिति मातर्याश्वनितीति वा ॥

> *apāmupastha upasthāne mahatyaṃtarikṣaloka āsīnā mahāṃta iti vāgṛhṇata*
> *mādhyamikā devagaṇā viśa iva rājānamupatasthu ryagniyamṛgyaṃtamiti*
> *vārcanīyamiti nā pūjanīyamiti vāharadyaṃ dūto devānāṃ vivasvata*
> *ādityādvi vasvādvivāsanavān preritavataḥ parāgatādvāpi vāsyāgnervaiśvānarasya*
> *mātariśvānamāhartāramāḍa* ‖
> *mātariśvā vāyurmā taryaṃtarikṣe śvasiti mātaryāśvanitīti vā* ‖

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska explains: "in the lap of the waters", in the great atmosphere world, seated, the great ones (mahānta), the divine hosts of the middle region, waited upon him as clans upon a king, upon the praiseworthy or the worshipful; the messenger of the gods, from Vivasvat, i.e. Āditya, the radiant, or from one sent, or from afar; Mātariśvan brought Vaiśvānara Agni[?402]. Mātariśvan is the wind: he breathes in the mātar (the atmosphere), or मातर्याश्वनितीति वा (*mātaryāśvanitīti vā*). (Ni. 7-26)

भावार्थ (Bhāvārtha)

And on this point another Ṛk is cited as an example. Near the lap of the waters, that is in the wide atmosphere world, the greatly glorious Mādhyamika (atmosphere-dwelling) gods welcomed this Agni. As subjects receive their king with great honour, so the gods welcomed and honoured this Agni, who is to be set forth by mantras, worshipful and venerable. Mātariśvan (the wind), who lives in the atmosphere, first impelled by the gods, brought Vaiśvānara-Agni from Āditya, who is in a very distant region. Vaiśvānara-Agni first became visible in the atmosphere to Mātariśvan himself. That Mātariśvan brought Vaiśvānara-Agni from near Āditya who was in the very distant region.

भावार्थ (Bhāvārtha)

Mātariśvan means the wind. The wind gets the name Mātariśvan either because it lives in the atmosphere or because it moves swiftly in the atmosphere. What is to be noted here is that it is said that the gods of the atmosphere brought Agni from the region where Sūrya is. No one can bring Sūrya from one region to another; only Agni can be brought. So it must be understood that here Vaiśvānara means the terrestrial fire. Besides, in many mantras the qualities of Sūrya (Āditya) are said of Vaiśvānara-Agni: in the twelfth Ṛk of the Haviṣkānta hymn, in the mantra विश्वस्मा अग्निं भुवनाय देवा वैश्वानरं केतुमह्नामकृण्वन् (*viśvasmā agniṃ bhuvanāya devā vaiśvānaraṃ ketumahnāmakṛṇvan*), it is said that the gods made Vaiśvānara-Agni the maker of the days (ahas). Although the quality of being the maker of the days belongs properly to Sūrya, here this quality is said of Vaiśvānara-Agni. For this Agni is said to be of the nature of all the deities in mantras such as अग्निः सर्वादेवताः (*agniḥ sarvādevatāḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 2-1-2) and इंद्रं मित्रं वरुणमग्निमाहुः (*iṃdraṃ mitraṃ varuṇamagnimāhuḥ*) (1-164-46); so it is common to ascribe to Agni the qualities of Sūrya and other deities. Therefore Vaiśvānara-Agni is the terrestrial fire, not Āditya.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अथैनमेताभ्यां सर्वाणि स्थानान्यभ्यापादं स्तौति ।
> मूर्धा भुवो भवति नक्तमग्निस्ततः सूर्यो जायते प्रातरुद्यन् ।
> मायामू तु यज्ञियानामेतामपो यत्तूर्णिश्चरति प्रजानन् ॥

> *athainametābhyāṃ sarvāṇi sthānānyabhyāpādaṃ stauti |*
> *mūrdhā bhuvo bhavati naktamagnistataḥ sūryo jāyate prātarudyan |*
> *māyāmū tu yajjiyānāmetāmapo yattūrṇiścarati prajānan ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Then with these two verses he praises him in all places from the foot. The verse says: the head of the world he becomes; at night he is Agni, then Sūrya is born rising at dawn; ... (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-6)[?403]

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> मूर्धा मूर्तमस्मिन्दीयते मूर्धायः सर्वेषां भूतानां भवति नक्तमग्निस्ततः सूर्यो जायते प्रातरुद्यन्
> स एव प्रज्ञां त्वेतां मन्यंते
> यज्ञियानां देवानां यज्ञसंपादिनामपो यत्कर्म चरति प्रजानन्
> सर्वाणि स्थानान्यनु संचरते त्वरमाणः ॥

> *mūrdhā mūrtamasmindīyate mūrdhāyaḥ sarveṣāṃ bhūtānāṃ bhavati naktamagnistataḥ sūryo jāyate prātarudyan sa eva prajñāṃ tvetāṃ manyaṃte*
> *yajñiyānāṃ devānāṃ yajñasaṃpādināmapo yatkarma carati prajānan*
> *sarvāṇi sthānānyanu saṃcarate tvaramāṇaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Yāska explains: mūrdhā, that on which the head is placed; he becomes the head of all beings; at night Agni, then Sūrya is born rising at dawn; he himself ... of the sacrificial gods who accomplish the sacrifice, the work he moves about knowing; hastening he moves through all places. (Ni. 7-27)[?404]

भावार्थ **(Bhāvārtha)**

The terrestrial fire is praised in many contexts as containing the distinguishing qualities of other special deities such as Sūrya. In this matter the author of the Nirukta has given two Ṛks as examples: for all living creatures Agni is absolutely necessary for life. Without Agni (the heat in the body, which is called Vaiśvānara-Agni) it is impossible to live. Such an Agni (the Agni in the form of Sūrya) shines at night as lord of the world that contains all creatures. In the morning the same Agni rises in the form of Sūrya. The gods can know the unique power and capacity of such an Agni, that is, how, being Sūrya by day and Agni by night, he carries out his duty.

Here Agni is said to be the lord of the night. To convey the meaning "lord", the word मूर्धा (*mūrdhā*) is used in this ṛk. This word comes to mean "lord" in the following way: among the various limbs of the body the head (mūrdhā, śiras) is the chief, as the saying सर्वस्य गात्रस्य शिरः प्रधानं (*sarvasya gātrasya śiraḥ pradhānaṃ*) shows. Therefore the use of the word mūrdhā here conveys the meaning "lord". The meaning is that Agni is the lord of all beings during the night. In the night, when there is no heat of the sun, Agni himself provides the beings with heat and light and discharges the sun's function. In the morning this same Agni rises as the sun and protects beings. The sages and others who perform sacrifice are able to know this power and capacity of the deities. The intention is that Agni has the power to move swiftly in all regions in order to do this work. That this ṛk says that Agni performs the sun's function is praise of Agni's uncommon quality; it does not mean that Agni is the Āditya. Or else it should be understood that this ṛk indicates that Agni possesses the powers and capacities of the other deities.

The following ṛk is for a fuller explanation of it.

स्तोमेन हि दिवि देवासो अग्निमजीजनञ्क्तिभी रोदसिप्रां । तनू अकृण्वन्त्रेधा भुवे कं स ओषधीः पचति विश्वरूपाः ॥ (*stomena hi divi devāso agnimajījanañktibhī rodasiprāṃ | tanū akṛṇvantredhā bhuve kaṃ sa oṣadhīḥ pacati viśvarūpāḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-10)

स्तोमेन हि यं दिवि देवा अग्निमजनयञ्क्तिभिः कर्मभिद्यावापृथिव्योः पूरणं तमकुर्वंस्त्रेधाभावाय पृथिव्यामंतरिक्षे दिवीति शाकपूणिः यदस्य दिवि तृतीयं तदसावादित्य इति हि ब्राह्मणं तदंगीकृत्य स्तौति. (*stomena hi yaṃ divi devā agnimajanayañktibhiḥ karmabhidyāvāpṛthivyoḥ pūraṇaṃ tamakurvaṃstredhābhāvāya pṛthivyāmaṃtarikṣe divīti śākapūṇiḥ yadasya divi tṛtīyaṃ tadasāvāditya iti hi brāhmaṇaṃ tadaṃgīkṛtya stauti.*) (Ni. 7-28).

The gods, by praise, brought Agni into being in heaven. That Agni, by his powers and capacities, filled and illumined heaven and earth. Again, those gods made that Agni three-formed. That Agni ripens all the plants (the herbs), that is, makes them grow and prosper.

The Agni whom the gods brought into being and established in heaven by the stoma (praise) pervaded heaven and earth by his powers and capacities. That is, the teacher Śākapūṇi says that the gods produced Agni in order that he might dwell in the three places: earth, atmosphere and heaven. In this matter there is also a Brāhmaṇa sentence यदस्य दिवि तृतीयं (*yadasya divi tṛtīyaṃ*) ...

... तदसावादित्यः (*tadasāvādityaḥ*): the third form of Agni which shines in heaven is that very Āditya who is visible to our eyes. Accepting this view, the seer praises Agni in the next ṛk.

अथैनमेतयादित्यीकृत्य स्तौति (*athainametayādityīkṛtya stauti*).

यदेदेनमदधुर्यज्ञियासो दिवि देवाः सूर्यमादितेयं । यदा चरिष्णू मिथुनावभूतामादित प्रापश्यन् भुवनानि विश्वा ॥ (*yadedenamadadhuryajjiyāso divi devāḥ sūryamāditeyaṃ | yadā cariṣṇū mithunāvabhūtāmādita prāpaśyan bhuvanāni viśvā ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-11).

यदैनमदधुर्यज्ञियाः सर्वे दिवि देवाः सूर्यमादितेयमदितेः पुत्रं यदा चरिष्णू मिथुनौ प्रादुरभूतां सर्वदा सहचारिणावुषाश्चादित्यश्च । म (*yadainamadadhuryajjiyāḥ sarve divi devāḥ sūryamāditeyamaditeḥ putraṃ yadā cariṣṇū mithunau prādurabhūtāṃ sarvadā sahacāriṇāvuṣāścādityaśca | ma*).

मिथुनौ कस्मान्मिनोतिः श्रयतिकर्मा, थु इति नामकरणस्थकारो वा नयतिः परो, वनिर्वा, समाश्रितावन्योन्यं नयतो, वनुतो वा, मनुष्यमिथुनावप्यैतस्मादेव, मेधंतावन्योन्यं वनुत इति वा. (*mithunau kasmānminotiḥ śrayatikarmā, thu iti nāmakaraṇasthakāro vā nayatiḥ paro, vanirvā, samāśritāvanyonyaṃ nayato, vanuto vā, manuṣyamithunāvapyaitasmādeva, medhaṃtāvanyonyaṃ vanuta iti vā.*).

(2. 72-9)[?405]

Accepting the view that this Agni is the Āditya, the seer praises with this ṛk. When the gods, worthy of sacrifice, established in heaven the sun, the son of Aditi, and when this pair of deities (Uṣas and Āditya) were created and began to move together, then they saw all the beings of the world.

When the gods, worthy of sacrifice, that is, praised in sacrifices and the like, established the Āditya (the sun), the son of Aditi, in heaven, and when the two who are mithunabhūta, that is, always together (the two, Uṣas and Āditya) came into being, from then on these two deities, Uṣas and Āditya, move always together and became able to see all the beings in the world.

Here the derivation of the word mithuna is given. The word mithuna is formed from the root minoti, which has the sense of "resorting to". That is: the root mi in the word mithuna has the meaning "resort to"; thu, or the letter tha, is the affix; the last letter na is from the root nayati (नयतिः परः (*nayatiḥ paraḥ*)), and indicates the meaning "leads" or "carries" another. So the word mithuna means two that resort to each other mutually and remain together. समाश्रित् अन्योन्यं प्रति आत्मानं नयतः कालं वा समाश्रितौ भवतः परस्परं संभक्तौ (*samāśrit anyonyaṃ prati ātmānaṃ nayataḥ kālaṃ vā samāśritau bhavataḥ parasparaṃ saṃbhaktau*)[?406]. That is, the word mithunau means two who resort to each other mutually, or, in respect of time, that after one time another comes

(night, day and so on) is the meaning it conveys. In the case of human beings too, the word mithuna means two persons who resort to each other, or who pass their time together in mutual affection.

अथैनमेतयाग्नीकृत्य स्तौति (*athainametayāgnīkṛtya stauti*).

यत्रा वदेते अवरः परश्च यज्ञन्योः कतरो नौ वि वेद । अ शेकुरित्सधमादं सखायो नक्षंत यज्ञं क इदं वि वोचत् ॥ (*yatrā vadete avaraḥ paraśca yajñanyoḥ kataro nau vi veda | a śekuritsadhamādaṃ sakhāyo nakṣaṃta yajñaṃ ka idaṃ vi vocat ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88-17).

यत्र विवदेते दौन्यौ होतारावयं चाग्निरसौ च मध्यमः कतरो नौ यज्ञे भूयो वेदेत्याशक्नुवंति सत्सहमदनं समानख्याना ऋत्विजस्तेषां यज्ञं समश्नुवानानां को न इदं विपक्ष्यतीति ॥ (*yatra vivadete daunyau hotārāvayaṃ cāgnirasau ca madhyamaḥ kataro nau yajñe bhūyo vedetyāśaknuvaṃti satsahamadanaṃ samānakhyānā ṛtvijasteṣāṃ yajñaṃ samaśnuvānānāṃ ko na idaṃ vipakṣyatīti ‖*) (Ni. 7-30).

Taking this Vaiśvānara Agni to be the earthly Agni, the seer praises with this ṛk. Of the lower and the upper Agnis who know the matter of sacrifice, which knows more? Who is able to decide this question? The ṛtvijs and others who take equal shares in the sacrifice are able to decide it.

दैन्य होतारौ (*dainya hotārau*) means the hotṛs of divine nature: the Agni named Hotṛ who invites the gods to the sacrifice. Since the word hotārau is in the dual, the two deities are the earthly (the sacrificial Agni) established on earth, and the Vāyu or lightning-Agni in the middle region. Since both are only other forms of Agni, they are addressed with the dual word hotārau. अवरः परश्च (*avaraḥ paraśca*) means "the lower and the upper". "Lower" is to be understood as the earthly Agni in the place of earth, and परः (*paraḥ*) as the Agni (lightning) in the middle region. Which of these two has the greater knowledge? Among the ṛtvijs who, taking equal shares, that is, the chief roles, in sacrificial rites, know the matter of sacrifice well, which ṛtvij is able to decide this question?

The following ṛk is for a fuller explanation of it.

यावन्मात्रमुषसो न प्रतीकं सुपर्णो,३वसते मातरिश्वः । तावद्धधात्युप यज्ञमायान्ब्राह्मणो होतुरवरो निषीदन् ॥ (*yāvanmātramuṣaso na pratīkaṃ suparṇo,3vasate mātariśvaḥ | tāvaddhadhātyupa yajñamāyānbrāhmaṇo hoturavaro niṣīdan ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 10-88)

यावन्मात्रमुषसः प्रत्यक्तं भवति प्रतिदर्शनमिति वास्तुपमानस्य संप्रत्यर्थे प्रयोग इहेव निधेहीति यथा सुपर्ण्यः सुपतना एता रात्रयो (*yāvanmātramuṣasaḥ pratyaktaṃ bhavati pratidarśanamiti vāstupamānasya saṃpratyarthe prayoga iheva nidhehīti yathā suparṇyaḥ supatanā etā rātrayo*)

वसते मातरिश्वन् ज्योतिर्वर्णस्य तावदुपदधाति यज्ञमागच्छन् ब्राह्मणो होतास्याग्नेर्होतुरवरो निषीदन् ॥ (*vasate mātariśvan jyotirvarṇasya tāvadupadadhāti yajñamāgacchan brāhmaṇo hotāsyāgnerhoturavaro niṣīdan ‖*) (Ni. 7-31)

Another ṛk is given as an example in this matter. In the previous ṛk Agni and Vāyu are praised; in this ṛk Agni alone is praised. Mātariśvan (Vāyu) asked a man: can the brāhmaṇa, the human hotṛ taking part in the sacrifice, hold, that is, know, the knowledge of Agni, the hotṛ of the gods (the understanding in the performance of sacrifice)? The man replied to this as follows. O Mātariśvan, for as long as (for how long) the birds of fine wings hold the dawn, for so long the brāhmaṇa, the human hotṛ, seated on the sacrificial altar near the sacrificial fire, in a place lower than Agni, holds it (that is, by Agni's grace knows it to a small extent).

The word न (*na*) in this ṛk does not have the sense of comparison; it has the sense of "now" (samprati). Just as the word iha means "here", yet the sentence इहैव निधेहि (*ihaiva nidhehi*) means "put it now", so it should be understood. Therefore the phrase यावनात्रमुषसो न प्रतीकं (*yāvanātramuṣaso na pratīkaṃ*)[?407] means: for as long as, that is, for how long (only a short time) the dawn-time at the end of the night spreads, for just so long. The sentence सुपर्ण्यः सुपतना एता रात्रयो वसते मातरिश्वन (*suparṇyaḥ supatanā etā rātrayo vasate mātariśvana*) means: O Mātariśvan, the birds of fine wings, flying, hold the dawn-time. That is, "birds" here means the nights. The word suparṇyaḥ which indicates this, meaning "of various wings", conveys the sense of the various (fine) colours of the dawn-time. Therefore suparṇyaḥ means that when Uṣas rises at the end of the night, that Uṣas has various or beautiful colours. The extent of this dawn-time is very small. Since sunrise follows very quickly after the dawn-time, the dawn-time is very small in extent: the intention is, only for a very short time. The human hotṛ is inferior to Agni, the divine hotṛ; therefore the brāhmaṇa, the human hotṛ, seated in a place lower than Agni installed on the sacrificial altar, performs the hotṛ's work only for a very short time, by the grace of Agni, who is of special wisdom: this is the main intention. By this the smallness of man and the greatness of Agni become evident. Since this ṛk says that the brāhmaṇa, the human hotṛ, seated on the sacrificial altar, performs the hotṛ's work praising Agni, the divine hotṛ, it is clearly evident that here Vaiśvānara Agni means the earthly Agni who is praised, and not the Āditya.

होतृजपस्त्वनग्निर्वैश्वानरीयो भवति देव सवितरेतु त्वा वृणतेऽग्निं होत्राय सह पित्रा वैश्वानरेणेतीममेवाग्निं सवितारमाह सर्वस्य प्रसवितारं मध्यमं वोत्तमं वा पितरं । यस्तु सूक्तं भजते यस्मै हविर्निरुप्यतेयमेव सोग्निर्वैश्वानरः । निसातमेवैते उत्तरे ज्योतिषी एतेन नामधेयेन भजेते भजेते ॥ (*hotṛjapastvanagnirvaiśvānarīyo bhavati deva savitaretu tvā vṛṇate* *'gniṃ hotrāya saha pitrā vaiśvānareṇetīmamevāgniṃ savitāramāha sarvasya prasavitāraṃ madhyamaṃ vottamaṃ vā pitaraṃ | yastu sūktaṃ bhajate yasmai havirnirupyateyameva sògnirvaiśvānaraḥ | nisātamevaite uttare jyotiṣī etena nāmadheyena bhajete bhajete ||*)

(Ni. 7-31).

The japa-mantras and the like recited by the hotṛ in the sacrifice praise Vaiśvānara by addressing him. The mantra-japa (is that of) Agni: देवसवितरेतं त्वा वृणतेऽग्निं होत्राय सह पित्रा वैश्वानरेण (*devasavitaretaṃ tvā vṛṇate 'gniṃ hotrāya saha pitrā vaiśvānareṇa*)[?408]. An explanation of the sentence "O shining god Savitṛ, the hotṛ has chosen you, that is, Agni, along with your father Vaiśvānara, for the praise" is necessary. Here the seer calls Agni himself Savitṛ. Here Savitṛ (the word savitṛ) means the producer of all things (or beings); the word is used here in this sense. He addresses as father either Vāyu, who belongs to the middle region, or the Āditya, who belongs to the highest (heavenly) place.

The god who is praised in the sūkta, and the god for whom (with whom in view) the oblation is offered, that Vaiśvānara is this earthly Agni.

As stated in sentences such as सूर्यो वैश्वानरः । अग्निर्वैश्वानरः । (*sūryo vaiśvānaraḥ | agnirvaiśvānaraḥ |*), the light of lightning-form in the middle region and the light of Āditya-form in heaven, both these lights, are spoken of by the one name Vaiśvānara. That is, the earthly Agni, spoken of by the word Vaiśvānara, shines in three forms: in heaven as Āditya, in the atmosphere as lightning, on earth as the earthly Agni: this is the main intention.

This is the … sūkta.[?409]

> चतुर्थे मंडले प्रथमेऽनुवाके दश सूक्तानि । वैश्वानरायेति पंचदशर्चं पंचमं सूक्तं नामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभं वैश्वानराग्नि देवताकं । अत्रानुक्रमणिका । वैश्वानराय वैश्वानरीयमिति ॥ विनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥

> *caturthe maṃḍale prathame 'nuvāke daśa sūktāni | vaiśvānarāyeti paṃcadaśarcaṃ paṃcamaṃ sūktaṃ nāmadevasyārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ vaiśvānarāgni devatākaṃ | atrānukramaṇikā | vaiśvānarāya vaiśvānarīyamiti || viniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the fourth Maṇḍala, in the first anuvāka, there are ten sūktas. The fifth, beginning वैश्वानराय (*vaiśvānarāya*), has fifteen ṛks; its seer is नामदेवस्य (*nāmadevasya*)[?410]; the metre is Triṣṭubh; the deity is Vaiśvānara Agni. The Anukramaṇikā says वैश्वानराय वैश्वानरीयमिति (*vaiśvānarāya vaiśvānarīyamiti*). The use in ritual (viniyoga) is laiṅgika, that is, by the indication of the text itself.

Anuvāda

In the first anuvāka of the fourth maṇḍala there are ten sūktas. Of them this sūkta beginning "Vaiśvānarāya" is the fifth. It has fifteen ṛks. Vāmadeva is the seer of this sūkta; Vaiśvānara Agni is the deity; Triṣṭubh is the metre. The Anukramaṇikā says: "vaiśvānarāya vaiśvānarāyam"[?411]. The use in ritual is laiṅgika.

Sūkta 5

Maṇḍala 4. Anuvāka 1. Sūkta 5. Aṣṭaka 3. Adhyāya 5. Vargas 1, 2, 3. Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 15. Seer: Vāmadeva. Deity: Vaiśvānara. Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वै॒श्वा॒न॒राय॑ मी॒ळ्हुषे॑ स॒जोषा॑ः क॒था दा॑शेमा॒ग्नये॑ बृ॒हद्भाः ।
अनू॑नेन बृ॒ह॒ता व॒क्षथे॒नोप॑ स्तभायदु॒प॒मिन्न रोध॑ः ॥ १ ॥

> *vaiśvānarāya mīḷhuṣe sajoṣāḥ kathā dāśemāgnaye bṛhadbhāḥ |*
> *anūnena bṛhatā vakṣathenopa stabhāyadupaminna rodhaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वैश्वानराय । मीळ्हुषे । सजोषाः । कथा । दाशेम । अग्नये । बृहत् । भाः ।
> अनूनेन । बृहता । वक्षथेन । उप । स्तभायत् । उपमित् । न । रोधः ॥ १ ॥

> *vaiśvānarāya | mīḷhuṣe | sajoṣāḥ | kathā | dāśema | agnaye | bṛhat | bhāḥ |*
> *anūnena | bṛhatā | vakṣathena | upa | stabhāyat | upamit | na | rodhaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सजोषाः सजोषसः समानप्रीतियुक्ता वयमृत्विग्यजमाना वैश्वानराय
> विश्वानरसंबंधिन एतन्नामकाय विळ्हुषेभिमतवृष्टादिसेक्रे बृहद्बृहते महते
> भा भासमानायाग्नये देवाय कथा कथं केन प्रकारेण दाशेम दद्याम। साम–

> *sajoṣāḥ sajoṣasaḥ samānaprītiyuktā vayamṛtvigyajamānā vaiśvānarāya*
> *viśvānarasaṃbaṃdhina etannāmakāya viḷhuṣebhimatavṛṣṭādisekre bṛhadbṛhate mahate*
> *bhā bhāsamānāyāgnaye devāya kathā kathaṃ kena prakāreṇa dāśema dadyāma| sāma-*

> र्थाद्धविरिति गम्यते । अथवा बृहद्भा इत्युत्तरत्र योज्यं । कथा दाशेमेत्युक्तं ।
> किं तत्राधिक्यमिति तदुच्यते । योग्निर्बृहन्महान्भा भासमानश्च सन् अनूनेनाविकलेन संपूर्णेन
> अत एव बृहता प्रभूतेन वक्षथेन वोढव्येन स्वशरीरेणोप
> स्तभायत् । उपस्तभ्याति । सामर्थ्याद्दिवामिति शेषः । द्युलोकं प्राप्नोतीत्यर्थः ।
> तत्र दृष्टांतः । उपमिन्न रोधः । उप समीपे मीयते क्षिप्यत इत्युपमित् स्थूणा।
> सा यथा तृणाच्छादनादिनिरोधकं वंशादिकमुपस्तभ्याति तद्वत् । यद्वा । वक्षथेनोक्तलक्षणेन
> फलादिवाहकेन स्तोत्रेण सह द्युलोकमुपस्तभायत् । स्तभायत्।
> स्तन्भुः सौत्रो धातुः । लजु छंदसि शायजपीति व्यत्ययेनाहावपि शायजादेशः ।
> बहुलं छंदसीत्यडागमाभावः । किमिव । उपमिन्न रोधः । उप समीपे मीयत
> इत्युपमिदुदकं । कूलमिव ॥

> *rthāddhaviriti gamyate | athavā bṛhadbhā ityuttaratra yojyaṃ | kathā dāśemetyuktaṃ |*
> *kiṃ tatrādhikyamiti taducyate | yognirbṛhanmahānbhā bhāsamānaśca san anūnenāvikalena saṃpūrṇena ata eva bṛhatā prabhūtena vakṣathena*

> *voḍhavyena svaśarīreṇopa*
> *stabhāyat | upastabhyāti | sāmarthyāddāmiti śeṣaḥ | dyulokaṃ*
> *prāpnotītyarthaḥ |*
> *tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | upaminna rodhaḥ | upa samīpe mīyate kṣipyata*
> *ityupamit sthūṇā|*
> *sā yathā tṛṇācchādanādinirodhakaṃ vaṃśādikamupastabhyāti tadvat |*
> *yadvā | vakṣathenoktalakṣaṇena phalādivāhakena stotreṇa saha*
> *dyulokamupastabhāyat | stabhāyat|*
> *stanbhuḥ sautro dhātuḥ | laju chaṃdasi śāyajapīti vyatyayenāhāvapi*
> *śāyajādeśaḥ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyaḍāgamābhāvaḥ | kimiva | upaminna rodhaḥ | upa*
> *samīpe mīyata*
> *ityupamidudakaṃ | kūlamiva ‖*

Summary

सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*): we, ṛtvijs and sacrificers, united in equal affection. वैश्वानराय (*vaiśvānarāya*): for the god of this name, who belongs to all men. मीळ्हुषे (*mīḷhuṣe*): to the sprinkler of desired things such as rain. बृहत् (*bṛhat*): great; भाः (*bhāḥ*): shining; to the god Agni, who is great and shining. कथा (*kathā*): how, in what manner, shall we give (दाशेम (*dāśema*))? By implication it is understood that the thing given is an oblation.

Or else बृहद्भाः (*bṛhadbhāḥ*) is to be joined with what follows. "How shall we give" has been said; what is the excellence in it? That is stated. The Agni who, being great and shining, with an unimpaired, complete, therefore abundant, "to-be-carried" (वक्षथेन (*vakṣathena*)) body of his own, props up (उपस्तभायत् (*upastabhāyat*); he props up) the heaven, "the heaven" being supplied from the sense; that is, he reaches the heavenly world. An illustration: उपमिन्न रोधः (*upaminna rodhaḥ*). उपमित् (*upamit*) is a post, which is placed (मीयते (*mīyate*)) near (उप (*upa*)); as it supports the bamboo or the like that holds the thatch, so he. Or else: with the praise, of the nature stated, that carries the fruits and so on (वक्षथेन (*vakṣathena*)), he props up the heaven. स्तभायत् (*stabhāyat*): the root stambh is a sautra root. Another alternative: उपमिन्न रोधः (*upaminna rodhaḥ*): उपमित् (*upamit*), "that which is measured near", is water; he is like a bank (कूलमिव (*kūlamiva*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- वैश्वानराय (*vaiśvānarāya*)—to him who is famed by the name Vaiśvānara
- मीळ्हुषे (*mīḷhuṣe*)—who bestows desired things
- बृहत् (*bṛhat*)—of vast form
- भाः (*bhāḥ*)—shining
- अग्नये (*agnaye*)—to Agni
- सजोषाः (*sajoṣāḥ*)—we, ṛtvijs and others
- कथा (*kathā*)—in what manner indeed
- दाशेम (*dāśema*)—shall we offer the oblation
- अनूनेन (*anūnena*)—complete, without deficiency
- बृहता (*bṛhatā*)—of vast form
- वक्षथेन (*vakṣathena*)—with his body
- रोधः (*rodhaḥ*)—the atmosphere
- उपमिन्न (*upaminna*)—as a pillar holds up a beam and keeps it standing
- उपस्तभायत् (*upastabhāyat*)—he has lifted and holds up

Gist

In what manner shall we, ṛtvijs and sacrificers, gathered together, offer the oblation to Agni, who is famed by the name Vaiśvānara, bestower of desired things, of vast form and shining? That same Vaiśvānara Agni, with his complete, vast body, has lifted and holds up the atmosphere, as a pillar holds up a beam.

English translation

How may we present rejoicing (fit offerings) to Agni, the showerer (of benefits) ; to Vaishwanara, he, who, bright with great lustre, sustains the heaven, with his entire vast and insupportable (bulk), as a pillar (sustains a roof).

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मा नि॑न्दत॒ य इ॒मां मह्यं॑ रा॒तिं दे॒वो द॒दौ मर्त्या॑
य स्व॒धावा॑न् ।
पाका॑य॒ गृत्सो॑ अ॒मृतो॒ विचे॑ता वैश्वान॒रो नृत॑मो य॒
ह्वो अ॒ग्निः ॥ २ ॥

> *mā nindata ya imāṃ mahyaṃ rātiṃ devo dadau martyāya svadhāvān |*
> *pākāya gṛtso amṛto vicetā vaiśvānaro nṛtamo yahvo agniḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> मा । निंदत । यः । इमां । मह्यं । रातिं । देवः । ददौ । मर्त्याय । स्वधावान् ।
> पाकाय । गृत्सः । अमृतः । विचेताः । वैश्वानरः । नृतमः । यह्वः । अग्निः ॥ २ ॥

> *mā | niṃdata | yaḥ | imāṃ | mahyaṃ | rātiṃ | devaḥ | dadau |*
> *martyāya | svadhāvān |*
> *pākāya | gṛtsaḥ | amṛtaḥ | vicetāḥ | vaiśvānaraḥ | nṛtamaḥ | yahvaḥ |*
> *agniḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे होत्रादयोऽमुं वैश्वानरमग्निं मा निंदत । निंदां मा कुरुत ।
> स्तुतेत्यर्थः । यो देवो दीप्यमानोऽग्निः स्वधावानस्मृद्दत्तेन हविर्लक्षणेनान्नेन
> तद्वान् सन् मर्त्याय मरणधर्माय पाकाय परिपक्वप्रज्ञाय मह्यं यजमानायेमामिदानीं
> दीयमानप्रकारां रातिं धनं ददौ । दत्तवान् । स विशेष्यते।
> गृतो मेधावी । मेधाविनामैतत् । अमृतोऽमरणस्वभावो विचेता विशिष्टप्रज्ञो वैश्वानरो
> विश्वैर्नरैराहवनीयादिरूपेण नीयमानो नृतमो नेतृतमः फलादीनां यह्वो महान् । महन्नामैतत् ।
> अग्निरंगनादिगुणविशिष्टः ।
> तादृशमग्निं स्तुतेति भावः ॥

> *he hotrādayo 'muṃ vaiśvānaramagniṃ mā niṃdata | niṃdāṃ mā kuruta*
> *|*
> *stutetyarthaḥ | yo devo dīpyamāno 'gniḥ svadhāvānasmṛddattena*
> *havirlakṣaṇenānnena*

> *tadvān san martyāya maraṇadharmāya pākāya paripakvaprajñāya mahyaṃ yajamānāyemāmidānīṃ dīyamānaprakārāṃ rātiṃ dhanaṃ dadau | dattavān | sa viśeṣyate|*
> *gṛto medhāvī | medhāvināmaitat | amṛto 'maraṇasvabhāvo vicetā viśiṣṭaprajño vaiśvānaro viśvairnarairāhavanīyādirūpeṇa nīyamāno nṛtamo netṛtamaḥ phalādīnāṃ yaho mahān | mahannāmaitat | agniraṃganādiguṇaviśiṣṭaḥ |*
> *tādṛśamagniṃ stuteti bhāvaḥ ||*

Summary

Sāyaṇa addresses the priests, the hotṛs and others: do not revile this Vaiśvānara Agni; praise him. The shining Agni, who is svadhāvān, possessed of the food in the form of the oblation given by us, has given this wealth, of the kind now being given, to me, the sacrificer, who am mortal and of ripened wisdom. He is further described: gṛtsa is "wise" (a name for the wise); he is immortal by nature, of distinguished understanding; Vaiśvānara, because he is led by all men in the forms of the Āhavanīya and the rest; nṛtama, the best leader, mighty (yahva is a name for "great") in fruits and the like; and Agni, endowed with the qualities of going and so on. The sense is: praise such an Agni.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—who
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—being resplendent
- स्वधावान् (*svadhāvān*)—and possessing food in the form of oblation
- मर्त्याय (*martyāya*)—to the mortal
- पाकाय (*pākāya*)—to one of ripened knowledge
- मह्यं (*mahyaṃ*)—to me
- इमां रातिं (*imāṃ rātiṃ*)—this wealth
- ददौ (*dadau*)—gave (such an Agni)
- मा निंदत (*mā niṃdata*)—do not revile (that Agni)
- गृत्सः (*gṛtsaḥ*)—wise
- अमृतः (*amṛtaḥ*)—free from mortality
- विचेताः (*vicetāḥ*)—of distinguished understanding

- वैश्वानरः (*vaiśvānaraḥ*)—carried by all
- नृतमः (*nṛtamaḥ*)—the best among leaders
- यह्वः (*yahvaḥ*)—great-souled
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—worthy of worship (he is)

Gist

Do not revile that Agni who, being resplendent and possessed of food in the form of oblation, has given this wealth to me, a mortal of ripened knowledge. That same Agni is wise, free from mortality, of distinguished understanding, carried by all, the best among leaders, great-souled and worthy of worship.

English translation

Reproach not the divine (Agni), who, accepting the oblation, has given the wealth to me, his mortal (worshipper) of mature (intellect); Agni, who is wise, immortal, discriminating, (who is) Vaishwanara, chief conductor (of rites), the mighty.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

साम॑ द्वि॒बर्हा॒ महि॑ ति॒ग्मभृ॑ष्टिः स॒हस्र॑रेता वृष॒भस्तुवि॑ष्मान् ।
प॒दं न गोरप॑गूळ्हं विवि॒द्वान॒ग्निर्म॒ह्यं प्रेदु॑ वोचन्मनी॒षाम् ॥ ३ ॥

> *sāma dvibarhā mahi tigmabhṛṣṭiḥ sahasraretā vṛṣabhastuviṣmān |*
> *padaṃ na gorapagūḷhaṃ vividvānagnirmahyaṃ predu vocanmanīṣām || 3 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> साम । द्विबर्हाः । महि । तिग्मभृष्टिः । सहस्ररेताः । वृषभः । तुविष्मान् ।
> पदं । न । गोः । अपगूळ्तं । विविद्वान् । अग्निः । मह्यं । प्र । इत् । ऊं इति ।
> वोचत् । मनीषां ॥ ३ ॥

> *sāma | dvibarhāḥ | mahi | tigmabhṛṣṭiḥ | sahasraretāḥ | vṛṣabhaḥ | tuviṣmān |*
> *padaṃ | na | goḥ | apagūḷtaṃ | vividvān | agniḥ | mahyaṃ | pra | it | ūṃ iti |*
> *vocat | manīṣāṃ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> द्विबर्हा द्वयोर्मध्यमोत्तमयोः स्थानयोः परिवृढस्तिग्मभृष्टिस्तीक्ष्णतेजाः सहस्ररेता
> बहुविधहिरण्यरेतस्कः रेतःशब्दः सारवाची । प्रभूतसारो ना ।
> वृषभो वर्षिता कामानां तुविष्टान्बहुधन ईदृशोऽयमग्निरत्यंतगोपितं गोः
> पदं न नष्टाया गोः पदमिवापगूळ्हमत्यंतरहस्यं । मनीषाशब्दो ज्ञानवाची
> सन्नत्र ज्ञातव्ये वर्तते । मनीषां ज्ञातव्यं महि महत्पूज्यं सामास्मदभिमतं
> स्तोत्रं विविद्वान् विशेषेण जानन् प्रेदु वोचत् । प्रैव ब्रवीतु ॥

> *dvibarhā dvayormadhyamottamayoḥ sthānayoḥ parivṛḍhastigmabhṛṣṭistīkṣṇatejāḥ sahasraretā*
> *bahuvidhahiraṇyaretaskaḥ retaḥśabdaḥ sāravācī | prabhūtasāro nā |*
> *vṛṣabho varṣitā kāmānāṃ tuviṣṭānbahudhana īdṛśo 'yamagniratyaṃtagopitaṃ goḥ*
> *padaṃ na naṣṭāyā goḥ padamivāpagūḷhamatyaṃtarahasyaṃ | manīṣāśabdo jñānavācī*
> *sannatra jñātavye vartate | manīṣāṃ jñātavyaṃ mahi mahatpūjyaṃ sāmāsmadabhimataṃ*
> *stotraṃ vividvān viśeṣeṇa jānan predu vocat | praiva bravītu ‖*

Summary

Dvibarhāḥ: encompassing the two places, the middle and the highest. Tigmabhṛṣṭi: of sharp splendour. Sahasrareta: possessing manifold golden seed (the word reta denotes essence; compare "of abundant essence"). Vṛṣabha: the showerer of desires. Tuviṣmān: rich in wealth. Such is this Agni. Like the footprint of a lost cow, which is hidden, the thing is utterly secret. The word manīṣā, denoting knowledge, here stands for what is to be known. May Agni, who knows especially the great, venerable sāman, the praise-song we desire, declare it forth to me.

Word-to-word meaning

- द्विबर्हाः (*dvibarhāḥ*)—he who occupies both the middle and the highest places
- तिग्मभृष्टिः (*tigmabhṛṣṭiḥ*)—of sharp splendour
- सहस्ररेताः (*sahasraretāḥ*)—of abundant essence
- वृषभः (*vṛṣabhaḥ*)—showerer of desires
- तुविष्टान् (*tuviṣṭān*)—possessing abundant wealth
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- गो पदं न (*go padaṃ na*)—like the footprint of cows that have been led away secretly
- अपगूह्नं (*apagūhnaṃ*)—utterly secret
- मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*)—to be known
- महि (*mahi*)—venerable
- साम (*sāma*)—the sāman, of the nature of praise
- विविद्वान् (*vividvān*)—knowing especially well
- मह्यं (*mahyaṃ*)—to me
- प्रेदु वोचत् (*predu vocat*)—may he teach so that I understand

Gist

May Agni, who occupies both the middle and the highest places, of sharp splendour, of abundant essence, showerer of desires, possessing abundant wealth, knowing especially well the sāman—utterly secret like the footprint of hidden cows, to be known necessarily by men, venerable and of the nature of praise—teach it to me so that I understand.

English translation

May Agni, filling both (the middling and most excellent condition), bright shining, of manifold vigour, the showerer of (benefits) the possessor of affluence, (who comprehends) by (his) wisdom the mysterious sacred hymn, as (they track) the footsteps of a (missing) cow, reveal (the sense) to me.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र ताँ अ॒ग्निर्ब॑भसत्ति॒ग्मज॑म्भ॒स्तपि॑ष्ठेन शो॒चिषा॒ यः सु॒राधा॑ः ।
प्र ये मि॒नन्ति॒ वरु॑णस्य॒ धाम॑ प्रि॒या मि॒त्रस्य॒ चेत॑तो ध्रु॒वाणि॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *pra tā~ agnirbabhasattigmajambhastapiṣṭhena śociṣā yaḥ surādhāḥ |*
> *pra ye minanti varuṇasya dhāma priyā mitrasya cetato dhruvāṇi ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्र । तान् । अग्निः । बभसत् । तिग्मृजंभः । तपिष्ठेन । शोचिषा । यः । सुराधाः ।

> *pra | tān | agniḥ | babhasat | tigmṛjaṃbhaḥ | tapiṣṭhena | śociṣā | yaḥ | surādhāḥ |*

> प्र । ये । मिनंति । वरुणस्य । धाम । प्रिया । मित्रस्य । चेततः । ध्रुवाणि ॥ ४ ॥

> *pra | ye | minaṃti | varuṇasya | dhāma | priyā | mitrasya | cetataḥ | dhruvāṇi ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> योऽग्निः सुराधाः शोभनधनः स तिग्मजंभस्तीक्ष्णदंष्ट्रः सन् तपिष्ठेन शोचिषातिशयेन शत्रूणां तापकेन तेजसा तान्वक्ष्यमाणान् द्वेष्टान्बभसत् ।
> प्रकर्षेण भर्त्सयतु । दहत्वित्यर्थः ॥ भस भर्त्सनदीप्योः । लेटीतश्च लोप इतीकारलोपः । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः ॥ तानित्युक्तं कानित्याह । ये द्वेषारश्चेततो जानतः । एतदुभयविशेषणं । मित्रस्य वरुणस्य च प्रिया प्रियाणि ध्रुवाणि
> स्थिराणि धाम धामानि तेजःस्थानानि कर्माणि ना प्र मिनंति । प्रकर्षेण हिंसंति ।
> मीञ् हिंसायां । मीनातेर्निगम इति ह्रस्वत्वं । विकरणस्वरः ॥

> *yo 'gniḥ surādhāḥ śobhanadhanaḥ sa tigmajaṃbhastīkṣṇadaṃṣṭraḥ san tapiṣṭhena śociṣātiśayena śatrūṇāṃ tāpakena tejasā tānvakṣyamāṇān dveṣṭānbabhasat |*
> *prakarṣeṇa bhartsayatu | dahatvityarthaḥ ‖ bhasa bhartsanadīpyoḥ |*

> *leṭītaśca lopa itīkāralopaḥ | leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ ‖ tānityuktaṃ kānityāha | ye dveṣāraścetato jānataḥ | etadubhayaviśeṣaṇaṃ | mitrasya varuṇasya ca priyā priyāṇi dhruvāṇi*
> *sthirāṇi dhāma dhāmāni tejaḥsthānāni karmāṇi nā pra minaṃti |*
> *prakarṣeṇa hiṃsaṃti |*
> *mīñ hiṃsāyāṃ | mīnāternigama iti hrasvatvaṃ | vikaraṇasvaraḥ ‖*

Summary

Agni, who is surādhāḥ, of excellent wealth, being sharp-toothed (tigmajambha), may with his most scorching radiance, which burns enemies, drive off and consume those haters to be named, "them". Who are they? Those enemies who, knowing (cetataḥ—this qualifies both Mitra and Varuṇa), do not diminish but violently injure the dear and firm abodes of splendour, that is, the rites, of Mitra and Varuṇa.

Word-to-word meaning

- ये (*ye*)—which enemies
- चेततः (*cetataḥ*)—the wise
- मित्रस्य वरुणस्य (*mitrasya varuṇasya*)—of Mitra and Varuṇa
- प्रिया (*priyā*)—dear
- ध्रुवाणि (*dhruvāṇi*)—firm
- धाम (*dhāma*)—abodes of splendour
- प्र मिनंति (*pra minaṃti*)—injure; those
- तान् (*tān*)—those enemies
- सुराधाः (*surādhāḥ*)—possessing excellent wealth
- तिग्मजंभः (*tigmajaṃbhaḥ*)—possessing a sharp weapon
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- तपिष्ठेन (*tapiṣṭhena*)—with scorching (of enemies)
- शोचिषा (*śociṣā*)—radiance
- प्र बभसत् (*pra babhasat*)—may he destroy

Gist

May Agni, of excellent wealth and sharp weapon, destroy with his enemy-burning radiance those enemies who injure the dear and firm abodes of splendour of the wise Mitra and Varuṇa.

English translation

May the sharp-toothed Agni, possessed of excellent wealth, consume with his fierce radiance those (adversaries) who injure the firm and valued glories of the sapient Varuna and Mitra.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒भ्रा॒तरो॒ न योष॑णो॒ व्यन्त॑ः पति॒रिपो॒ न जन॑यो दु॒रेवा॑ः ।
पा॒पास॒ः सन्तो॑ अनृ॒ता अ॑स॒त्या इ॒दं प॒दम॑जनता गभी॒रम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *abhrātaro na yoṣaṇo vyantaḥ patiripo na janayo durevāḥ |*
> *pāpāsaḥ santo anṛtā asatyā idaṃ padamajanatā gabhīram ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभ्रातरः । न । योषणः । व्यंतः । पतिरिपः । न । जनयः । दुःएवाः ।
> पापासः । संतः । अनृताः । असत्याः । इदं । पदं । अजनत । गभीरं ॥ ५ ॥

> *abhrātaraḥ | na | yoṣaṇaḥ | vyaṃtaḥ | patiripaḥ | na | janayaḥ | duḥevāḥ |*
> *pāpāsaḥ | saṃtaḥ | anṛtāḥ | asatyāḥ | idaṃ | padaṃ | ajanata | gabhīraṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अभ्रातरो भ्रातादिबंधुरहिता योषणो न गतभर्तृका योषित इव ॥ वा
> षपूर्वस्य निगम इति विकल्पनाद्ीर्घाभावः ॥ ता यथा भर्तृगृहापित्यृहं प्रत्यायंति तद्वद्व्यंतो
> गच्छंतः । यज्ञादीनपहायामार्गे वर्तमाना इत्यर्थः । तथा
> पतिरिपो न जनयः पतिद्वेषिण्यः स्त्रिय इव दुरेवा दुष्टगतयो दुराचारा आत
> एव पापासः पापाः संतोऽनृता मानससत्यरहिता असत्या वाचिकसत्यरहिता मनसा
> वाचाग्निमभजमाना इदं पापिभिरनुभूयमानतया प्रसिद्धं गभीरमगाधं पदं
> नरकस्थानमजनत । अजनयंत । उत्पादयंति ॥ लजि जनेरंतर्भावितण्यर्थाद्व्यत्ययेनैकवचनं
> ॥

> *abhrātaro bhrātādibaṃdhurahitā yoṣaṇo na gatabhartṛkā yoṣita iva ‖ vā ṣapūrvasya nigama iti vikalpanādīrghābhāvaḥ ‖ tā yathā bhartṛgṛhāpitṛrhaṃ pratyāyaṃti tadvadvyaṃto gacchaṃtaḥ | yajñādīnapahāyāmārge vartamānā ityarthaḥ | tathā patiripo na janayaḥ patidveṣiṇyaḥ striya iva durevā duṣṭagatayo durācārā āta*
> *eva pāpāsaḥ pāpāḥ saṃto 'nṛtā mānasasatyarahitā asatyā vācikasatyarahitā manasā*
> *vācāgnimabhajamānā idaṃ pāpibhiranubhūyamānatayā prasiddhaṃ gabhīramagādhaṃ padaṃ*
> *narakasthānamajanata | ajanayaṃta | utpādayaṃti ‖ laji janeraṃtarbhāvitaṇyarthādvyatyayenaikavacanaṃ ‖*

Summary

Like women without brothers and other kinsfolk, widows, who go back to their father's house, so these go: abandoning sacrifice and the like, they proceed on the wrong path. Likewise, like women hostile to their husbands, they are evil-going and ill-behaved; therefore sinners, false in mind (anṛta) and in speech (asatya), not worshipping Agni with mind and speech. They produce this well-known deep, unfathomable place, hell, experienced by sinners.

Word-to-word meaning

- अभ्रातरः योषणः न (*abhrātaraḥ yoṣaṇaḥ na*)—like women who have neither brother nor husband
- व्यंतः (*vyaṃtaḥ*)—going to their father's house for protection
- पतिरिपः (*patiripaḥ*)—hating the husband
- जनयः न (*janayaḥ na*)—like women
- दुरेवाः (*durevāḥ*)—of evil conduct
- पापासः संतः (*pāpāsaḥ saṃtaḥ*)—being sinful
- अनृताः (*anṛtāḥ*)—of false thought
- असत्याः (*asatyāḥ*)—of false dealing; the wicked
- इदं (*idaṃ*)—fit to be experienced by sinners
- गभीरं (*gabhīraṃ*)—unfathomable
- पदं (*padaṃ*)—the place of hell
- अजनत (*ajanata*)—they produce

Gist

The wicked—of evil conduct, sinful, of false thought and false dealing, like a woman without brother or husband going for protection to her father's house, and like a woman who hates her husband—produce the unfathomable place of hell, fit to be experienced by sinners.

English translation

Like women who have no brethren, going (about from their own to their father's house), women adverse to their lords going astray, so the wicked, false (in thought), false (in speech), they give birth to this deep abyss (of hell).

Ṛk 6

Samhitā-pāṭha

इ॒दं मे॑ अग्ने॒ किय॑ते पाव॒कामि॑नते गु॒रुं भा॒रं न मन्म॑ ।
बृ॒हद्द॑धाथ धृष॒ता ग॑भी॒रं य॒ह्वं पृ॒ष्ठं प्रय॑सा स॒प्तधा॑तु ॥ ६ ॥

> *idaṃ me agne kiyate pāvakāminate guruṃ bhāraṃ na manma |*
> *bṛhaddadhātha dhṛṣatā gabhīraṃ yahvaṃ pṛṣṭhaṃ prayasā saptadhātu ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इदं । मे । अग्ने । कियते । पावक । अमिनते । गुरुं । भारु । न । मन्म ।
> बृहत् । दधाथ । धृषता । गभीरं । यह्वं । पृष्ठं । प्रयसा । सप्तधातु ॥ ६ ॥

> *idaṃ | me | agne | kiyate | pāvaka | aminate | guruṃ | bhāru | na | manma |*
> *bṛhat | dadhātha | dhṛṣatā | gabhīraṃ | yahvaṃ | pṛṣṭhaṃ | prayasā | saptadhātu ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे पावक शोधकाग्ने कियतेत्यल्पाय गुरं भारं न वोढुमशक्यं भारमिव । तं यथा धर्तुमसहमानः पातयति तद्वत्त्वदीयं कर्मामिनतेहिंसतेत्यजते मे मह्यमिदं ज्ञातव्यत्वेन प्रसिद्धं बृहत्पभूतं मन्म मननीयं धनं
> दधाध । देहि । तदेव विशेष्यते । दृषता शत्रूणां धर्षकेण प्रयसा । अन्ननामैतत् । अन्नेन युक्तं गभीरमन्यैरनवगाह्यं यह्वं महत्पृष्ठं स्प्रष्टुं योग्यं
> सप्तधातु ग्राम्यारण्यभेदेन सप्तप्रकारं । सप्त ग्राम्याः पशवः सप्तारण्याः । तै. सं.
> ७–२–२ इति श्रुतेः । ईदृग्धनं देहीत्यर्थः । गुरुं भारु न अन्यदीयं भारं यथान्यस्मै ददाति तद्वदस्माकं दातव्यं धनं देहीति वा योज्यं ॥

> *he pāvaka śodhakāgne kiyatetyalpāya guraṃ bhāraṃ na voḍhumaśakyaṃ bhāramiva | taṃ yathā dhartumasahamānaḥ pātayati tadvattvadīyaṃ karmāminatehiṃsatetyajate me mahyamidaṃ jñātavyatvena prasiddhaṃ bṛhatpabhūtaṃ manma mananīyaṃ dhanaṃ dadhādha | dehi | tadeva viśeṣyate | dṛṣatā śatrūṇāṃ dharṣakeṇa prayasā | annanāmaitat | annena yuktaṃ gabhīramanyairanavagāhyaṃ yahvaṃ mahatpṛṣṭhaṃ spraṣṭuṃ yogyaṃ*
> *saptadhātu grāmyāraṇyabhedena saptaprakāraṃ | sapta grāmyāḥ paśavaḥ saptāraṇyāḥ | tai. saṃ.*
> *7-2-2 iti śruteḥ | īdṛgdhanaṃ dehītyarthaḥ | guruṃ bhāru na anyadīyaṃ bhāraṃ yathānyasmai dadāti tadvadasmākaṃ dātavyaṃ dhanaṃ dehīti vā yojyaṃ ||*

Summary

O purifying Agni, as one unable to bear a heavy burden lets it fall, so the rite meant for you, that is not injured (amināte) by me, is not abandoned. Give me this well-known abundant, thought-worthy wealth. It is described: given by the bold one who crushes enemies, joined with food (prayas is a name for food), deep, not to be fathomed by others, great, a back fit to be touched, sevenfold (saptadhātu) by the division into village and forest animals, according to the śruti सप्त ग्राम्याः पशवः सप्तारण्याः । तै. सं. ७-२-२ (*sapta grāmyāḥ paśavaḥ saptāraṇyāḥ | tai. saṃ. 7-2-2*) (Tai. Saṃ. 7-2-2). The sense: give such wealth. Or else "gurum bhāru na" is to be construed: as one gives another's burden to another, so give us the wealth that is to be given.

Word-to-word meaning

- पावक (*pāvaka*)—purifying
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- गुरुं भारं (*guruṃ bhāraṃ*)—bearing an exceedingly heavy burden
- कियते न (*kiyate na*)—like a weak and small man
- अमिनते (*aminate*)—who does not abandon the rite directed to you
- मे (*me*)—to me
- इदं (*idaṃ*)—well-known
- बृहत् (*bṛhat*)—abundant

Pratipadārtha (continued)

- *bṛhat*—vast (continued from the previous page)
- मन्म (*manma*)—worthy of worship
- धृषता (*dhṛṣatā*)—that overpowers enemies
- पयसा (*payasā*)—together with food
- गभीरं (*gabhīraṃ*)—very deep
- यह्वं (*yahvaṃ*)—great
- पृष्टं (*pṛṣṭaṃ*)—pleasant to the touch
- सप्तधातु (*saptadhātu*)—consisting of seven elements
- दधाध (*dadhādha*)—become the giver

Gist

O purifying Agni, to me, who am like a feeble and weak man bearing an exceedingly heavy load, and who do not abandon the rite directed to you, give that well-known, abundant, worshipful wealth, which comes together with food that overpowers enemies, which is very deep, great, pleasant to the touch, and consisting of the seven elements.

English translation

Purifier, Agni, bestow on me, not neglecting your worship, this acceptable and vast (wealth), like a hevy load on a feeble (bearer), together with invigorating food; (wealth), secure, abundant, tangible, and consisting of the seven elements.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तमिन्न्वे॒३॑व स॑म॒ना स॑मा॒नम॒भि क्रत्वा॑ पुन॒ती धी॒तिर॑श्याः ।
स॒सस्य॒ चर्म॒न्नधि॒ चारु॒ पृश्ने॒रग्रे॑ रु॒प आरु॑पितं॒ जबा॑रु ॥ ७ ॥

> *taminnveva samanā samānamabhi kratvā punatī dhītiraśyāḥ |*
> *sasasya carmannadhi cāru pṛśneragre rupa ārupitaṃ jabāru ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । इत् । नु । एव । समना । समानं । अभि । क्रत्वा । पुनती । धीतिः । अश्याः ।
> ससस्य । चर्मन् । अधि । चारु । पृश्नेः । अग्रे । रुपः । अरुपितं । जबारु ॥ ७ ॥

> *taṃ | it | nu | eva | samanā | samānaṃ | abhi | kratvā | punatī | dhītiḥ | aśyāḥ |*
> *sasasya | carman | adhi | cāru | pṛśneḥ | agre | rupaḥ | arupitaṃ | jabāru ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्निविद्युदादित्यास्त्रयोऽपि मतभेदेन वैश्वानरशब्दाभिधेया इति । नि. ७–२३ ।
> यस्केनोक्तत्वादत्रादित्यात्मना वैश्वानरः स्तूयते । तमित्तमेव वैश्वानरं द्युस्थानं
> समानं सर्वेषामेकरूपं समना सदृशी तद्योग्या पुनत्यस्मान् शोधयित्रि
> धीतिर्मतिरस्मदीया स्तुतिः क्रत्वा तदुचीतेन कर्मणा नेव क्षिप्रमेवाश्याः अभिप्राप्नुयात् ।
> भजेदित्यर्थः अश्नोतेर्लिजि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य लुक् । व्यत्य–

> *agnividyudādityāstrayo 'pi matabhedena vaiśvānaraśabdābhidheyā iti | ni. 7-23 |*
> *yaskenoktatvādatrādityātmanā vaiśvānaraḥ stūyate | tamittameva vaiśvānaraṃ dyusthānaṃ*
> *samānaṃ sarvèṣāmekarūpaṃ samanā sadṛśī tadyogyā punatyasmān śodhayitri*

> *dhītirmatirasmadīyā stutiḥ kratvā taducītena karmaṇā neva kṣiprameväśyāḥ abhiprāpnuyāt | bhajedityarthaḥ aśnoterliji bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya luk | vyatya-*

> येन परस्मैपदं मध्यमपुरुषत्वं च ॥ पूर्वत्र तच्छब्दश्रुतेर्यच्छब्दोऽध्याहार्यः । यस्य द्युस्थानस्य वैश्वानरस्य जबारु जवमानरोहि जरमाणरोहि वा
> चारु दीप्तं मंडलं । जबारु जरमाणरोहीति वा जवमानरोहीति वेति यास्कः ।
> नि. ६.१७ । अग्रे पुरस्तात्पूर्वस्यां दिशि रूपः । आरोपयति स्वात्मनि सस्यादीनि रुबिति भूमिरुच्यते । तस्याः सकाशात्ससस्य । लुप्तोपममेतत् । स्वपत इव निश्चलस्य पृश्नेः । द्युनामैतत् स्वः पृश्निरिति द्युलोकादित्ययोः साधारणनामसु पाठात् । ज्योतिरादिभिः स्पृश्यमानस्य द्युलोकस्याधि उपरि चर्मन् चर्मणे चरणाय ॥ चरेराणादिको मनिन् । सुपां सुलुगिति चतुर्था लुक् ॥ आरुपितमारोपितं देवैः ।
> तमश्या इति पूर्वत्रान्वयः !

> *yena parasmaipadaṃ madhyamapuruṣatvaṃ ca ‖ pūrvatra tacchabdaśruteryacchabdo 'dhyāhāryaḥ | yasya dyusthānasya vaiśvānarasya jabāru javamānarohi jaramāṇarohi vā*
> *cāru dīptaṃ maṃḍalaṃ | jabāru jaramāṇarohīti vā javamānarohīti veti yāskaḥ |*
> *ni. 6.17 | agre purastātpūrvasyāṃ diśi rūpaḥ | āropayati svātmani sasyādīni rubiti*
> *bhūmirucyate | tasyāḥ sakāśātsasasya | luptopamametat | svapata iva niścalasya pṛśneḥ |*
> *dyunāmaitat svaḥ pṛśniriti dyulokādityayoḥ sādhāraṇanāmasu pāṭhāt |*
> *jyotirādibhiḥ spṛśyamānasya dyulokasyādhi upari carman carmaṇe caraṇāya ‖ carerāṇādiko manin | supāṃ sulugiti caturthā luk ‖*
> *ārupitamāropitaṃ devaiḥ |*
> *tamaśyā iti pūrvatrānvayaḥ !*

Summary

Agni, lightning and the Sun are all, according to differing views, denoted by the word Vaiśvānara, as Yāska says (Ni. 7-23); so here Vaiśvānara is praised in the form of the Sun. "That very Vaiśvānara", dwelling in heaven, is समानं (*samānaṃ*), of one form for all. समना (*samanā*) is "similar", fit for him; पुनती (*punatī*) is purifying us; धीतिः (*dhītiḥ*) is our thought, our praise. With क्रत्वा (*kratvā*), the rite suited to it, may it quickly reach him, that is, serve him. (The remainder of the block, on the verb form and its irregularities, is grammar and continues on the next page.)

Since the word "tat" is heard in the earlier part, "yat" must be supplied: the one whose जबारु (*jabāru*), "swiftly rising" or "rising in old age", is the shining orb. Yāska: जबारु जरमाणरोहीति वा जवमानरोहीति (*jabāru jaramāṇarohīti vā javamānarohīti*) (Ni. 6-17). अग्रे (*agre*) means in front, in the eastern direction. रुपः (*rupaḥ*) is the earth, so called because it carries crops and the like; it is "from" the earth. The comparison is elided: "like one asleep", the motionless पृश्नेः (*pṛśneḥ*). This is a name of heaven, since "svaḥ" and "pṛśni" are read among the names common to heaven and the sun. Above the heaven touched by the lights, चर्मन् (*carman*) means "for moving". आरुपितं (*ārupitaṃ*) is "set up" by the gods. "Tam aśyāḥ" connects with what precedes.

Word-to-word meaning

- यस्य (*yasya*)—of which Vaiśvānara
- जबारु (*jabāru*)—swiftly rising
- चारु (*cāru*)—brilliant, the orb
- अग्रे (*agre*)—being in front of the sacrificial fire
- ससस्य (*sasasya*)—motionless
- पृश्नेः (*pṛśneḥ*)—of heaven
- अधि (*adhi*)—in the upper part
- चर्मन् (*carman*)—to move
- रुपः (*rupaḥ*)—from the earth
- आरुपितं (*ārupitaṃ*)—raised up (placed in heaven)
- तमित् (*tamit*)—that very Vaiśvānara
- समानं (*samānaṃ*)—since he is the same to gods, humans and others
- समना (*samanā*)—fit to be offered to him
- पुनती (*punatī*)—purifying all
- धीतिः (*dhītiḥ*)—(our) praise
- क्रत्वा (*kratvā*)—joined with the fitting rite
- स्नव (*snava*)—quickly

- अश्याः (*aśyāḥ*)—may it pervade

Gist

The swiftly rising, brilliant orb of that Vaiśvānara was raised up from the earth, stationed in front of the sacrificial fire, to move in the motionless heaven. That same Vaiśvānara, being the same to gods, humans and all, may our praise, fit to be offered to him and purifying all, joined with the rite suited to it, quickly pervade.

English translation

May our (self)-purifying praise, suited to his glory, and accompanied by worship, quickly attain to that omniform (Vaishwanara) whose swift- ascending brilliant (orb) is stationed on the east of the earth, to mount, like the sun, above the immoveable heaven.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्र॒वाच्यं॒ वच॑स॒ः किं मे॑ अ॒स्य गुहा॑ हि॒तमुप॑ नि॒णिग्व॑दन्ति ।
यदु॒स्रिया॑णा॒मप॒ वारि॑व॒ व्रन्पाति॑ प्रि॒यं रु॒पो अग्रं॑ प॒दं वेः ॥ ८ ॥

> *pravācyaṃ vacasaḥ kiṃ me asya guhā hitamupa niṇigvadanti |*
> *yadusriyāṇāmapa vāriva vranpāti priyaṃ rupo agraṃ padaṃ veḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्रवाच्यं । वचसः । किं । मे । अस्य । गुहा । हितं । उप । निणिक् । वदंति ।
> यत् । उस्रियाणां । अप । वाः इव । व्रन् । पाति । प्रियं । रुपः । अग्रं । पदं ।
> वेरितिवेः ॥ ८ ॥

> *pravācyaṃ | vacasaḥ | kiṃ | me | asya | guhā | hitaṃ | upa | niṇik | vadaṃti |*
> *yat | usriyāṇāṃ | apa | vāḥ iva | vran | pāti | priyaṃ | rupaḥ | agraṃ | padaṃ |*
> *veritiveḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मे मदीयास्यास्य वक्ष्यमाणस्य वचसो वाक्यस्य किं प्रवाच्यमस्ति । तथ्यमेवोच्यत इत्यर्थः । किं तद्वच इत्युच्यते । उस्रियाणां । गोनामैतत् । क्षीराद्युत्सावीणीनां गवां संबंधि यत्कीरं
> वारिवोदकमिन तद्यथा सेकेनाविष्कुर्वंति
> तथाप व्रन् । अपवृण्वंति । दोग्धारो निणिक् । नितरां नेनेक्ति शोधयतीति निणिक्
> क्षीरमुच्यते । तादृक् क्षीरमनेन वैश्वानरेण गुहा गुहायामुप हितमुपनिहितं
> वदंति वेत्तारः । किंचायं वेर्वाप्ताया रुपो भूम्याः प्रियं सर्वेषामाधारत्वेन प्रियभूतमग्रं श्रेष्ठं पदं स्थानं पाति । रक्षति ॥

> *me madīyāsyāsya vakṣyamāṇasya vacaso vākyasya kiṃ pravācyamasti | tathyamevocyata ityarthaḥ | kiṃ tadvaca ityucyate | usriyāṇām | gonāmaitat | kṣīrādyutsāvīṇīnāṃ gavāṃ saṃbaṃdhi yatkīraṃ*
> *vārivodakamina tadyathā sekenāviṣkurvaṃti*
> *tathāpa vran | apavṛṇvaṃti | dogdhāro niṇik | nitarāṃ nenekti śodhayatīti niṇik*
> *kṣīramucyate | tādṛk kṣīramanena vaiśvānareṇa guhā guhāyāmupa hitamupanihitaṃ*
> *vadaṃti vettāraḥ | kiṃcāyaṃ vervāptāyā rupo bhūmyāḥ priyaṃ sarveṣāmādhāratvena priyabhūtamagraṃ śreṣṭhaṃ padaṃ sthānaṃ pāti | rakṣati ‖*

Summary

"What is there to be said (प्रवाच्यं (*pravācyaṃ*)) of this word of mine that is to be spoken?" That is, only the truth is spoken. What is that word? उस्रियाणां (*usriyāṇāṃ*) is a name for cows. The milk of the cows that yield milk and so on, as people draw water, so they uncover it by milking (अप व्रन् (*apa vran*)). निणिक् (*niṇik*) is milk, since it cleanses thoroughly. The knowers say that such milk is placed in the cave (गुहा (*guhā*)) by this Vaiśvānara. Further, he protects the dear, foremost place of the earth, which is pervaded (वेः (*veḥ*)), dear as the support of all.

Word-to-word meaning

- उस्रियाणां (*usriyāṇāṃ*)—of the cows
- यत् (*yat*)—which milk (the milkers)
- वारिव (*vāriva*)—like water
- अप व्रन् (*apa vran*)—obtained
- निणिक् (*niṇik*)—that same milk
- गुहा (*guhā*)—in a cave
- उप हितं (*upa hitaṃ*)—as placed
- वदंति (*vadaṃti*)—the wise say (and that the same milk)
- वेः (*veḥ*)—of the pervading
- रुपः (*rupaḥ*)—to the earth
- प्रियं (*priyaṃ*)—dear
- अग्रं (*agraṃ*)—excellent
- पदं (*padaṃ*)—place
- पाति (*pāti*)—protects (so they say)
- मे (*me*)—my
- अस्य वचसः (*asya vacasaḥ*)—in this word that tells the truth
- किं प्रवाच्यं (*kiṃ pravācyaṃ*)—what fault is there?

Gist

The knowers say that the milk of the cows, which the milkers obtained like water, Vaiśvānara has placed in a cave, and that this same milk protects the dear and excellent place of the all-pervading earth.

(The Bhāvārtha continues:) What fault is there in this word of mine, which conveys that truth?

English translation

What objection (can be offered) to this my assertion, that they affirm that the milk of the cows, which (the milkers) obtain like water, is placed in concealment (by Vaishwanara), and cherishes the excellent and valued expanse of the wide earth.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒दमु॒ त्यन्महिं॑ म॒हामनीं॑क॒ं यदु॒स्रिया॒ सचं॑त पू॒र्व्यं

गौः ।

ऋ॒तस्यं॑ प॒दे अधि॒ दीद्यां॑न॒ं गुहां॑ रघु॒ष्यद्रं॑घु॒यद्विं॑वेद

॥ ९ ॥

> *idamu tyanmahi mahāmanīkaṃ yadusriyā sacata pūrvyaṃ gauḥ |*
> *ṛtasya pade adhi dīdyānaṃ guhā raghuṣyadraghuyadviveda ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इदं । ऊं इति । त्यत् । महि । महां । अनेकं । यत् । उस्रिया । सचत । पूर्व्यं ।
> गौः ।
> ऋतस्य । पदे । अधि । दीद्यानं । गुहा । रघुऽस्यत् । रघुऽयत् । विवेद । ९ ॥

> *idaṃ | ūṃ iti | tyat | mahi | mahāṃ | anekaṃ | yat | usriyā | sacata |*
> *pūrvyaṃ |*
> *gauḥ |*
> *ṛtasya | pade | adhi | dīdyānaṃ | guhā | raghu 'syat | raghu 'yat |*
> *viveda | 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इदमु इदमेव त्यत्पसिद्धं महि महत्तूज्यं महां महतां देवानामनीकं समूहरूपं सूर्यमंडलं वैश्वानर एवेति शेषः । पूर्व्यं पूर्वकालीनं पूरकं वा यन्मंडलमुस्रिया क्षीराद्युत्साविणी गौरग्निहोत्राद्यर्थं सचत । सेवते । ऋतस्योदकस्य पदे स्थानेंतरिक्षेऽध्यधिकं । यद्वा । अधीति सप्तम्यर्थानुवादः । दीद्यानं द्योतमानं गुहा गुहायां रघुष्यत् शीघ्रं स्यंदमानं रघुयत् शीघ्रं गच्छत्सूर्यमंडलं विवेद । वैश्वानरमेवेति ज्ञातवानस्मि ॥

> *idamu idameva tyatpasiddhaṃ mahi mahattūjyaṃ mahāṃ mahatāṃ devānāmanīkaṃ samūharūpaṃ sūryamaṃḍalaṃ vaiśvānara eveti śeṣaḥ | pūrvyaṃ pūrvakālīnaṃ pūrakaṃ vā yanmaṃḍalamusriyā kṣīrādyutsāviṇī gauragnihotrādyarthaṃ*
> *sacata | sevate | ṛtasyodakasya pade sthāneṃtarikṣe 'dhyadhikaṃ |*

> *yadvā | adhīti saptamyarthānuvādaḥ | dīdyānaṃ dyotamānaṃ guhā guhāyāṃ raghuṣyat śīghraṃ syaṃdamānaṃ*
> *raghuyat śīghraṃ gacchatsūryamaṃḍalaṃ viveda | vaiśvānarameveti jñātavānasmi ‖*

Summary

इदमु (*idamu*): this very, that well-known great, worshipful *anīkaṃ* of the great gods, of the form of a multitude, the solar orb, is Vaiśvānara himself (so the sense is completed). पूर्व्यं (*pūrvyaṃ*) is "belonging to former times" or "fulfilling". The orb which the milk-yielding cow (उस्रिया (*usriyā*)) serves for the agnihotra and the like. ऋतस्य पदे (*ṛtasya pade*): in the place of water, the atmosphere; अधि (*adhi*) is "exceedingly"; or else अधि (*adhi*) restates the sense of the locative. दीद्यानं (*dīdyānaṃ*) is shining; गुहा (*guhā*) in a cave; रघुष्यत् (*raghuṣyat*) flowing swiftly; रघुयत् (*raghuyat*) moving swiftly: that solar orb "I have known" (विवेद (*viveda*)) to be Vaiśvānara himself.

Word-to-word meaning

- पूर्व्यं (*pūrvyaṃ*)—ancient
- यत् (*yat*)—which solar orb
- उस्रिया (*usriyā*)—milk-yielding
- गौः (*gauḥ*)—cows
- सचित (*sacita*)—serve, and
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of water
- पदे (*pade*)—in the place, the atmosphere
- अधि (*adhi*)—exceedingly
- दीद्यानं (*dīdyānaṃ*)—shining
- गुहा (*guhā*)—hidden in a cave
- रघुष्यत् (*raghuṣyat*)—spreading swiftly
- रघुयत् (*raghuyat*)—moving quickly, the solar orb
- विवेद (*viveda*)—I have known (which is it?)
- तृत् (*tṛt*)—the well-known
- महि (*mahi*)—great
- महां अनेकं (*mahāṃ anekaṃ*)—the solar orb, of the form of a multitude of the great gods
- इदमु (*idamu*)—this Vaiśvānara fire

Gist

I have known the ancient solar orb which the milk-yielding cows serve, which shines exceedingly in the atmosphere, the place of water, hidden in a cave, spreading swiftly and moving fast. Which is it? That well-known, great solar orb, of the form of a multitude of the great gods, is this Vaiśvānara fire.

English translation

I recognize this adorable assemblage of the great (deities), which from of old the milk-shedding cow affects, shining above the region of the water, (the firmament), in secret ; swift-gliding, swift-moving.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अध॑ द्युता॒नः पि॒त्रोः स॒चासाम॑नु॒त गुह्यं॒ चारु॒ पृश्ने॑ः ।
मा॒तुष्प॒दे प॑र॒मे अन्ति॒ षद्गोर्वृष्ण॑ः शो॒चिष॒ः प्रय॑तस्य जि॒ह्वा ॥ १० ॥

> *adha dyutānaḥ pitroḥ sacāsāmanuta guhyaṃ cāru pṛśneḥ |*
> *mātuṣpade parame anti ṣadgorvṛṣṇaḥ śociṣaḥ prayatasya jihvā ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अध । द्युतानः । पित्रोः । सचा । आसा । अमनुत । गुह्यं । चारु । पृश्नेः ।
> मातुः । पदे । परमे । अंति । सत् । गोः । वृष्णः । शोचिषः । प्रयतस्य । जिह्वा॥

> *adha | dyutānaḥ | pitroḥ | sacā | āsā | amanuta | guhyaṃ | cāru | pṛśneḥ |*
> *mātuḥ | pade | parame | aṃti | sat | goḥ | vṛṣṇaḥ | śociṣaḥ | prayatasya | jihvā‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अध अथ द्युतानो दीप्यमानः पित्रोर्द्यावापृथिव्योः सचा सह मध्ये
> व्याप्तः सन् पृश्नेर्गौः संबंधि चारु रमणीयं गुह्यमूधसि निगूढं पय आसा
> [52] Vol, 17.
> [52] Vol, 17.

> *adha atha dyutāno dīpyamānaḥ pitrordyāvāpṛthivyoḥ sacā saha madhye*
> *vyāptaḥ san pṛśnergòḥ saṃbaṃdhi cāru ramaṇīyaṃ guhyamūdhasi*
> *nigūḍhaṃ paya āsā*
> *[52] Vol, 17.*
> *[52] Vol, 17.*

> स्वकीयेनास्येनामनुत । पानायाबुध्यत । उक्तमेवार्थं विवृणोति । मातुः
> क्षीरादिनिर्मात्रा गोः परमे पद उत्कृष्टे स्थान ऊधोलक्षणेऽंति सत् समीपे
> विद्यमानं क्षीरं वृष्णः फलानां वर्षितुः शोचिषो दीप्तस्य प्रयतस्याहवनीयादिरूपेण नियतस्य
> वैश्वानरस्य जिह्वा पातुमिच्छतीति शेषः ॥

> *svakīyenāsyenāmanuta | pānāyābudhyata | uktamevārthaṃ vivṛṇoti |*
> *mātuḥ*
> *kṣīrādinirmātrā goḥ parame pada utkṛṣṭe sthāna ūdholakṣaṇe 'ṃti sat*
> *samīpe*
> *vidyamānaṃ kṣīraṃ vṛṣṇaḥ phalānāṃ varṣituḥ śociṣo dīptasya*
> *prayatasyāhavanīyādirūpeṇa niyatasya vaiśvānarasya jihvā*
> *pātumicchatīti śeṣaḥ ||*

Summary

अध (*adha*) is "then". Shining, pervading together (सचा (*sacā*)) the middle between the two parents, heaven and earth, he, being so, desired (अमनुत (*amanuta*): awoke, to drink) with his own mouth (आसा (*āsā*)) the lovely milk of the cow (पृश्नेः (*pṛśneḥ*)) hidden in the udder. (The block breaks off here; it continues on the next page.)

(Continuing.) He is awakened to drink. He then explains the same sense: of the mother (मातुः (*mātuḥ*)), the cow that makes milk and the like, in her excellent place (परमे पदे (*parame pade*)), the udder, the milk existing close by (अंति सत् (*aṃti sat*)): the tongue of Vaiśvānara, the showerer (वृष्णः (*vṛṣṇaḥ*)) of fruits, the radiant (शोचिषः (*śociṣaḥ*)), the one regulated (प्रयतस्य (*prayatasya*)) in the forms of āhavanīya and the like, desires to drink — this is what is understood to complete the sentence.

Word-to-word meaning

- अध (*adha*)—afterwards
- द्युतानः (*dyutānaḥ*)—shining
- पित्रोः सचा (*pitroḥ sacā*)—Vaiśvānara, who is joined with heaven and earth
- पृश्नेः (*pṛśneḥ*)—of the cow
- चारु (*cāru*)—lovely
- गुह्यं (*guhyaṃ*)—hidden in the udder, the milk
- आसा (*āsā*)—with his mouth
- अमनुत (*amanuta*)—desired to drink
- मातुः (*mātuḥ*)—of the milk-giving
- गोः (*goḥ*)—cow
- परमे पदे (*parame pade*)—in the excellent udder
- अंति सत् (*aṃti sat*)—the milk that remains hidden
- वृष्णः (*vṛṣṇaḥ*)—of the one who showers desires
- शोचिषः (*śociṣaḥ*)—shining
- प्रयतस्य (*prayatasya*)—regulated in the forms of āhavanīya and the like, of Vaiśvānara
- जिह्वा (*jihvā*)—the tongue (desires to drink)

Gist

Vaiśvānara, shining and joined with heaven and earth, desired to drink with his mouth the cow's lovely milk hidden in the udder. The tongue of Vaiśvānara fire, the showerer of desires, shining, regulated in the forms of āhavanīya and the like, desires to drink the milk that remains hidden in the excellent udder of the milk-giving cow.

English translation

Then, radiant in association with the parents, (heaven and earth), he isa wakened (to drink) the agreeable secretion of the cow, and the tongue of the assiduous (performer of holy rites), the resplendent showerer of benefits,) approaching the excellent station of the maternal (cow), seeks to drink the milk.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तं वो॑चे॒ नम॑सा पृ॒च्छ्यमा॑न॒स्तवा॒शसा॑ जातवे॒दो य
दी॒दम् ।
त्वम॒स्य क्षं॑यसि॒ यद्ध॒ विश्वं᳚ दि॒वि यदु॒ द्रविं॑णं॒ यत्पृं॑
थि॒व्याम् ॥ ११ ॥

> *ṛtaṃ voce namasā pṛcchyamānastavāśasā jātavedo yadīdam |*
> *tvamasya kṣayasi yaddha viśvaṃ divi yadu draviṇaṃ yatpṛthivyām ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतं । वोचे । नमसा । पृच्छ्यमानः । तव । आशसा । जातवेदः । यदि । इदं ।
> त्वं । अस्य । क्षयसि । यत् । ह । विश्वं । दिवि । यत् । ऊं इति । द्रविणं । यत् ।
> पृथिव्यां ॥ ११ ॥

> *ṛtaṃ | voce | namasā | pṛcchyamānaḥ | tava | āśasā | jātavedaḥ | yadi | idaṃ |*
> *tvaṃ | asya | kṣayasi | yat | ha | viśvaṃ | divi | yat | ūṃ iti | draviṇaṃ | yat |*
> *pṛthivyāṃ ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अहं यजमानो नमसा नमस्कारेण सह पृच्छ्यमानोऽनैरनुयुज्यमानः सन् ऋतं वोचे । सत्यं ब्रवीमि । किं तदित्युच्यते । हे जातवेदो जातानां
> वेदितर्जातप्रज्ञ वाग्ने तवाशसा त्वत्सुत्या साधनेन यदीदं धनं लब्धमस्माभिः

> स्यात् अस्य धनस्य त्वं क्षयसि । त्वमेवेश्वरो भवसि । तस्य धनस्य
> यज्ञादिद्वाराग्न्यर्थत्वादिति भावः । अत्यल्पमिदमुक्तं । यद्ध विश्वं यत्पलु कृत्स्नं धनमस्ति
> तस्यापीशिषे । विश्वमिति सामान्येन यदुक्तं तदेव विशदयति । दिवि द्युलोके
> यदु द्रविणं यदेव धनं यच्च पृथिव्यां धनं तस्य सर्वस्य त्वमीश्वरो भवसि ।
> यज्ञार्थं द्रव्यमुत्पन्नमिति स्मरणात् । अग्नि व्यतिरेकेण यज्ञा संभवादिति भावः ॥

> *ahaṃ yajamāno namasā namaskāreṇa saha pṛcchyamāno*
> *'nairanuyujyamānaḥ san ṛtaṃ voce | satyaṃ bravīmi | kiṃ tadityucyate | he jātavedo jātānāṃ*
> *veditarjātaprajña vāgne tavāśasā tvatsutyā sādhanena yadīdaṃ dhanaṃ labdhamasmābhiḥ*
> *syāt asya dhanasya tvaṃ kṣayasi | tvameveśvaro bhavasi | tasya dhanasya yajñādidvārāgnyarthatvāditi bhāvaḥ | atyalpamidamuktaṃ |*
> *yaddha viśvaṃ yatpalu kṛtsnaṃ dhanamasti*
> *tasyāpīśiṣe | viśvamiti sāmānyena yaduktaṃ tadeva viśadayati | divi dyuloke*
> *yadu draviṇaṃ yadeva dhanaṃ yacca pṛthivyāṃ dhanaṃ tasya sarvasya tvamīśvaro bhavasi |*
> *yajñārthaṃ dravyamutpannamiti smaraṇāt | agni vyatirekeṇa yajñā saṃbhavāditi bhāvaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: I, the sacrificer, being questioned by others, speak the truth ऋतं वोचे (*ṛtaṃ voce*), together with homage. What that is, is now stated. "O Jātavedas, knower of what is born, O Agni, by your āśas, that is, by the means of your praise, whatever wealth may have been obtained by us, of this wealth you are lord; you alone are its master, because by way of sacrifice and the like that wealth is for Agni." Even this is said to be very little: whatever whole wealth there is, of that too you are master. What was said in general by "viśvam" he now makes clear: whatever wealth is in heaven, and whatever wealth is on earth, of all that you are lord. He grounds this in the tradition that wealth was produced for the sake of sacrifice; without Agni no sacrifice is possible, such is the sense.

Word-to-word meaning

- नमसा (*namasā*)—with homage

- पृच्छ्यमानः (*pṛcchyamānaḥ*)—I (the sacrificer), who am questioned
- ऋतं वोचे (*ṛtaṃ voce*)—I declare this answer which is the truth (namely)
- जातवेदः (*jātavedaḥ*)—O Jātavedas
- तव आशसा (*tava āśasā*)—obtained by the means of your praise
- यदि इदं (*yadi idaṃ*)—whatever this wealth is
- अस्य (*asya*)—of it
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- क्षयसि (*kṣayasi*)—are lord
- यत् ह विश्वं (*yat ha viśvaṃ*)—in the whole world
- दिवि (*divi*)—in the heavenly world
- यत् उ द्रविणं (*yat u draviṇaṃ*)—whatever wealth there is
- यत् पृथिव्यां (*yat pṛthivyāṃ*)—whatever wealth there is on the earth (of all that you alone are master)

Gist

I, the sacrificer, who am questioned with homage, declare this answer which is the truth. It is this: O Jātavedas, of this wealth obtained by the means of your praise, and also of all the wealth spread through the heavenly world and the earthly world, you alone are the master.

English translation

Interrogated with respect, I declare the truth, that this (wealth is acquired), Jatavedas, by the praise of you : you rule over it, (over) all that (it may be), the wealth that is in heaven or on earth.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

किं नो॑ अ॒स्य द्रवि॑णं॒ कद्ध॒ रत्नं॒ वि नो॑ वोचो जातवेदश्चिकि॒त्वान् ।
गुहाध्व॑नः पर॒मं यन्नो॑ अ॒स्य रेकु॑ प॒दं न नि॑दा॒ना अग॑न्म ॥ १२ ॥

> *kiṃ no asya draviṇaṃ kaddha ratnaṃ vi no voco jātavedaścikitvān |*
> *guhādhvanaḥ paramaṃ yanno asya reku padaṃ na nidānā aganma ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> किं । नः । अस्य । द्रविणं । कत् । ह । रत्नं । वि । नः । वोचः । जातवेदः । चिकित्वान् ।
> गुहा । अध्वनः । परमं । यत् । नः । अस्य । रेकु । पदं । न । निदानाः ।
> अगन्म ॥ १२ ॥

> *kiṃ | naḥ | asya | draviṇam | kat | ha | ratnam | vi | naḥ | vocaḥ | jātavedaḥ | cikitvān |*
> *guhā | adhvanaḥ | paramam | yat | naḥ | asya | reku | padam | na | nidānāḥ |*
> *aganma ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पूर्वमंत्रेण यस्य धनस्याग्निस्वामित्वमुक्तमस्य धनस्य किं द्रविणं किं साधनभूतं नोऽस्मभ्यं दातव्यं धनमस्ति । कद्ध रत्नं किंच रमणीयं हितकरं धनमस्ति ।
> तद्धनं हे जातवेदो जातधनाग्ने चिकित्वांश्चेतनानावानभिज्ञस्त्वं नोऽस्मभ्यं वि वोचः । विब्रूहि । यद्वा । किं दातव्यं द्रविणमस्ति । अस्य द्रविणराशेः कद्ध रत्नमिति योज्यं । अस्याध्वनो धनप्राप्तिमार्गस्य यद्गुहा गुहायां निहितं गूढं परममुत्कृष्टं प्राप्तव्यमस्ति तदपि नोऽस्मभ्यं विवोचः । वयं रेकु रिक्तं पदं गंतव्यं
> स्थानं गृहादिकं निदाना अन्नैर्निंद्यमानाः ॥ कर्मणि कर्तृप्रत्ययः ॥ नागन्म । न प्राप्पुमः ॥

> *pūrvamamṃtreṇa yasya dhanasyāgnisvāmitvamuktamasya dhanasya kiṃ draviṇaṃ kiṃ sādhanabhūtaṃ no 'smabhyaṃ dātavyaṃ dhanamasti | kaddha ratnaṃ kiṃca ramaṇīyaṃ hitakaraṃ dhanamasti | taddhanaṃ he jātavedo jātadhanāgne cikitvāṃścetanānāvānabhijñastvaṃ no 'smabhyaṃ vi vocaḥ | vibrūhi | yadvā | kiṃ dātavyaṃ draviṇamasti | asya draviṇarāśeḥ kaddha ratnamiti yojyaṃ | asyādhvano dhanaprāptimārgasya yadduhā guhāyāṃ nihitaṃ gūḍhaṃ paramamutkṛṣṭaṃ prāptavyamasti tadapi no 'smabhyaṃ vivocaḥ | vayaṃ reku riktaṃ padaṃ gaṃtavyaṃ sthānaṃ gṛhādikaṃ nidānā annairniṃdyamānāḥ ‖ karmaṇi kartṛpratyayaḥ ‖ nāganma | na prāppumaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: of the wealth over which Agni's lordship was stated in the previous mantra, what is the dravinam, what wealth, as a means, is to be given to us? And what ratna, what pleasing and beneficial wealth, is there? That wealth, O Jātavedas, Agni who knows what is born, you who are cikitvān, endowed with understanding and knowing, declare to us (vi vocaḥ, "explain"). Or else: what dravinam is there to be given? The phrase कद्ध रत्नं (*kaddha ratnaṃ*) is to be connected with "of this heap of wealth". Whatever in this path (adhvan) of the attainment of wealth lies hidden in a cave, is supreme and excellent and is to be reached, that too declare to us. May we not go to an empty (rekku, rikta) place, a house and the like that is to be gone to, being reproached (nidānāḥ) by others; that is नागन्म (*nāganma*), "we do not reach".

Word-to-word meaning

- अस्य (*asya*)—to that wealth (of which Agni is the lord)
- किं द्रविणं (*kiṃ draviṇaṃ*)—what is the value?
- नः (*naḥ*)—of this wealth of ours
- कद्द रत्नं (*kadda ratnaṃ*)—what is the chief use? (in what way is it beneficial?)
- जातवेदः (*jātavedaḥ*)—O all-knowing Agni

- चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*)—you who know everything
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- वि वोचः (*vi vocaḥ*)—explain clearly
- अस्य अध्वनः (*asya adhvanaḥ*)—of this path of the attainment of wealth
- यत् गुहा (*yat guhā*)—what is hidden
- परमं (*paramaṃ*)—and the most excellent place
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us (make known)
- रेकु (*reku*)—empty
- पदं (*padaṃ*)—place
- निदानाः (*nidānāḥ*)—reproached (by others)
- न अगन्म (*na aganma*)—may we not reach it

Gist

What is the value of the wealth of which Agni is the lord? In what way is this wealth beneficial? O all-knowing Agni, you who know everything, explain it clearly to us. Make known to us the hidden and most excellent place on the path of the attainment of wealth, and may we, reproached by others, not reach an empty place.

English translation

What is the value of this (wealth) to us? what's its advantage? Inform us, Jatavedas, for you know ; (tell us) what is the best (course) for us on this secret path, so that we may follow unreproached the direct road.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

का म॒र्यादा॑ व॒युना॒ कद्ध॑ वा॒मच्छा॑ गमेम र॒घवो॒
न वाज॑म् ।
क॒दा नो॑ दे॒वीर॒मृत॑स्य॒ पत्नी॒ः सूरो॒ वर्णे॑न ततनन्नु॒
षास॑ः ॥ १३ ॥

> *kā maryādā vayunā kaddha vāmamacchā gamema raghavo na vājam |*
> *kadā no devīramṛtasya patnīḥ sūro varṇena tatanannuṣāsaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> का । मर्यादा । वयुना । कत् । ह । वामं । अच्छ । गमेम । रघवः । न । वाजं।
> कदा । नः । देवीः । अमृतस्य । पत्निः । सूरः । वर्णेन । ततनन् । उषसः ॥ १३ ॥

> *kā | maryādā | vayunā | kat | ha | vāmaṃ | accha | gamema | raghavaḥ | na | vājaṃ|*
> *kadā | naḥ | devīḥ | amṛtasya | patniḥ | sūraḥ | varṇena | tatanan | uṣasaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> का मर्यादा का प्रीत्यादिव्यवस्था का च वयुना प्रज्ञानं पदार्थविषयं
> कद्ध किं च नामं वननीयं पदार्थजातं । एतत्सर्वमच्छ गमेम । अभिगच्छेम ।

> *kā maryādā kā prītyādivyavasthā kā ca vayunā prajñānaṃ padārthaviṣayaṃ*
> *kaddha kiṃ ca nāmaṃ vananīyaṃ padārthajātaṃ | etatsarvamaccha gamema | abhigacchema |*

> तत्र दृष्टांतः । रघवो न वाजं ! शीघ्रगामिनोऽश्वादयः संग्राममिव तद्वत् ।
> कदा कस्मिन्काले नोऽस्माकं व्यवहाराय देवीर्देव्यो द्योतमाना अमृतस्यामरणधर्मस्यादित्यस्य षत्नीः पत्नीः पालयित्र्यः सूरः प्रसवित्र्य उषासो वर्णेन
> प्रकाशेन ततनन् । विस्तारयेयुः । एवं सूर्यसंबंधिन उषसः स्तुत्या सर्वात्मनो वैश्वानरस्य स्तुतिरवगंतव्या ॥ तनोतेर्लेटि बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य श्लुः ।
> द्विर्भावहलादिशेषौ ॥

> *tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | raghavo na vājaṃ ! śīghragāmino 'śvādayaḥ saṃgrāmamiva tadvat |*
> *kadā kasminkāle no 'smākaṃ vyavahārāya devīrdevyo dyotamānā amṛtasyāmaraṇadharmasyādityasya ṣatnīḥ patnīḥ pālayitryaḥ sūraḥ prasavitrya uṣāso varṇena*
> *prakāśena tatanan | vistārayeyuḥ | evaṃ sūryasaṃbaṃdhina uṣasaḥ stutyā sarvātmano vaiśvānarasya stutiravagaṃtavyā ‖ tanoterleṭi bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya śluḥ |*
> *dvirbhāvahalādiśeṣau ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: what is the marygādā, what is the arrangement (vyavasthā) of affection and the like; and what is vayunā, knowledge concerning things; and what class of desirable things (vāmam) is there? All this may we approach (acchā gameṃma, "may we go up to").

Sāyaṇa says: the illustration is रघवो न वाजं (*raghavo na vājaṃ*): as swift-going horses and the like go to battle. When, at what time, for our dealings, would the shining (devīḥ) dawns, the wives (patnīḥ, "protectresses") of the immortal Āditya, who is of deathless nature, the sūraḥ ("bringers-forth"), spread (tatanan) with varṇa, that is, with radiance? Thus, by this praise of the dawns connected with the sun, the praise of Vaiśvānara, the self of all, is to be understood.

Word-to-word meaning

वाजं (*vājaṃ*)	for battle
रघवो न (*raghavo na*)	like swift-going horses
अच्छ (*accha*)	towards our desired region
गमेम (*gamema*)	(the region) to which we go
मर्यादा (*maryādā*)	the limit (of it)
का (*kā*)	what is it?
वयुना (*vayunā*)	the object that becomes perceptible to our knowledge there
कद्द (*kadda*)	what indeed is there?
वामं (*vāmaṃ*)	what is its use?
कदा (*kadā*)	when
नः (*naḥ*)	for our dealings
देवीः (*devīḥ*)	the shining
अमृतस्य (*amṛtasya*)	of the deathless Āditya
पत्नीः (*patnīḥ*)	the wives
सूरः (*sūraḥ*)	who bring forth the world
उषासः (*uṣāsaḥ*)	the dawn goddesses
वर्णेन (*varṇena*)	with their splendours
ततनन् (*tatanan*)	will light up the world

Gist

Like swift-going horses that run for battle, we go towards our desired region: what is the limit of that region? What object that becomes perceptible to our knowledge is there, and what is its use? When will the dawn goddesses, shining for our dealings, wives of the deathless Āditya and bringers-forth of the world, light up the world with their splendours?

English translation

What is the limit, what are the objects, which is the desirable (end) to which we rush like swift (chargers) to the battle? when for us will the divine dawns, the brides of the immortal (sun), overspread (the world) with light.

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒नि॒रेण॒ वच॑सा फ॒ल्ग्वे॑न प्र॒तीत्ये॑न कृ॒धुना॑तृ॒पास॑ः ।
अधा॒ ते अ॑ग्ने॒ किमि॒हा व॑दन्त्यनायु॒धास॒ आस॑ता सचन्ताम् ॥ १४ ॥

> *anireṇa vacasā phalgvena pratītyena kṛdhunātṛpāsaḥ |*
> *adhā te agne kimihā vadantyanāyudhāsa āsatā sacantām ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अनिरेण । वचसा । फल्ग्येन । प्रतीत्येन । कृधुना । अतृपासः ।
> अध । ते । अग्ने । किं । इह । वदंति । अनायुधासः । असता सचंतां ॥ १४ ॥

> *anireṇa | vacasā | phalgyena | pratītyena | kṛdhunā | atṛpāsaḥ |*
> *adha | te | agne | kiṃ | iha | vadaṃti | anāyudhāsaḥ | asatā sacaṃtāṃ ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अनिरेण । इरान्नं । तद्रहितेन फल्गनोक्केन प्रतीत्येन प्रतिगंतव्येन ।
> आरोह्येणेत्यर्थः । कृधुना ह्रस्वेन । कृद्विति ह्रस्वनाम कृधुको वम्रक इति तन्नामसूक्तत्वात् ।
> एवंविधेन वचसातृपासोऽतृप्ता जनाः । अध अधुनेहास्मिन् लोके
> हे अग्ने ते त्वां किं वदंति । निर्हविष्केण वचसा न किंचिल्लभ्यत इत्यर्थः। किंत्वनायुधासः।
> आयुधशब्दः साधनं लक्षयति। हविरादिसाधनरहितास्तेऽसता दुःखेन सचंतां।
> संगच्छंतां ॥

> *anireṇa | irānnaṃ | tadrahitena phalganokkena pratītyena pratigaṃtavyena |*
> *ārohyeṇetyarthaḥ | kṛdhunā hrasvena | kṛdviti hrasvanāma kṛdhuko vamraka iti tannāmasūktatvāt | evaṃvidhena vacasātṛpāso 'tṛptā janāḥ | adha adhunehāsmin loke*
> *he agne te tvāṃ kiṃ vadaṃti | nirhaviṣkeṇa vacasā na kiṃcillabhyata ityarthaḥ| kiṃtvanāyudhāsaḥ| āyudhaśabdaḥ sādhanaṃ lakṣayati| havirādisādhanarahitāste 'satā duḥkhena sacaṃtāṃ|*
> *saṃgacchaṃtāṃ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: anirena: ira is food; by speech devoid of it; phalguna[?][412]; pratītyena, "to be approached", that is, "to be climbed" (ārohya); kṛdhunā, "short": kṛdhu is a name for "short", as the lists of its names show (कृधुको वम्रक इति (*kṛdhuko vamraka iti*)). By speech of such kind, unsatisfied (atṛpāsaḥ) people, now (adha) here in this world, O Agni, what do they say to you? By speech without oblation nothing is obtained, that is the sense. But anāyudhāsaḥ: the word āyudha stands for a means; those devoid of means such as oblations, let them meet with asat, that is, with suffering (sacantām, "let them come together").

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अनिरेण (*anireṇa*)—devoid of food
- फल्गेन (*phalgena*)—worthless
- प्रतीत्येन (*pratītyena*)—devoid of what is defined[?][413]
- कृधुना (*kṛdhunā*)—very short

- वचसा (*vacasā*)—with speech
- अतृपासः (*atṛpāsaḥ*)—unsatisfied
- अध (*adha*)—now
- इह (*iha*)—in this place of sacrifice
- ते (*te*)—addressing you
- किं वदंति (*kiṃ vadaṃti*)—what indeed can they say?
- अनायुधासः (*anāyudhāsaḥ*)—they who are devoid of the means in the form of oblation
- असता (*asatā*)—with suffering
- सचंतां (*sacaṃtāṃ*)—let them be joined

Gist

O Agni, unsatisfied by speech that is devoid of food, worthless, devoid of what is defined, and very short, what indeed can they now say here in this place of sacrifice, addressing you? Devoid of the means in the form of oblation, let them be filled with suffering.

English translation

(Men are) not satisfied by unproductive, frivolous, inconclusive, scanty speech; then what, Agni, do they here say to you? devoid of the implements (of worship), let them suffer from distress

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्य श्रि॒ये स॑मिधा॒नस्य॒ वृष्णो॒ वसो॒रनी॑कं॒ दम॒
आ रु॑रोच ।
रुश॒द्वसा॑नः सु॒दृशी॑करूपः क्षि॒तिर्न रा॒या पु॑रु॒वारो॑ अ
द्यौत् ॥ १५ ॥

> *asya śriye samidhānasya vṛṣṇo vasoranīkaṃ dama ā ruroca |*
> *ruśadvasānaḥ sudṛśīkarūpaḥ kṣitirna rāyā puruvāro adyaut* ‖ 15 ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्य । श्रिये । संइधानस्य । वृष्णः । वसोः। अनेकं । दमे । आ । रुरोच ।
> रुशत् । वसानः । सुदृशीकरूपः । क्षितिः । न । राया । पुरुवारः । अद्यात् ॥ १५ ॥

> *asya | śriye | saṃidhānasya | vṛṣṇaḥ | vasoḥ| anekaṃ | dame | ā | ruroca |*
> *ruśat | vasānaḥ | sudṛśīkarūpaḥ | kṣitiḥ | na | rāyā | puruvāraḥ | adyāt ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> समिधानस्य समिध्यमानस्य ॥ कर्मणि कर्तृप्रत्ययः ॥ वृष्णो वर्षितुः फलस्य
> वसोऽर्वासयितुरस्याग्नेरनीकं तेजःसंघो दमे यागगृह आ रुरोच । सर्वतो
> दीप्यते । किमर्थं । श्रिये श्रेयसे यजमानानां । सोऽग्नि रुशत् । वर्णनामैतत् । दीप्तं तेजो
> वसान आच्छादयन् अत एव सुदृशीकरूपः सुष्टु दर्शनीयरूपः पुरुवारो
> बहुभिऋत्विग्भिर्यजमानैर्वर्णनीयः सन्नद्यौत् । द्योतते ।
> किमिव । रायाश्वादिधनेन क्षितिर्न राजादिरिव । क्षितिरिति मनुष्यनाम ॥

> *samidhānasya samidhyamānasya ‖ karmaṇi kartṛpratyayaḥ ‖ vṛṣṇo varṣituḥ phalasya*
> *vaso 'rvāsayiturasyāgneranīkaṃ tejaḥsaṃgho dame yāgagṛha ā ruroca | sarvato*
> *dīpyate | kimarthaṃ | śriye śreyase yajamānānāṃ | so 'gni ruśat | varṇanāmaitat | dīptaṃ tejo vasāna ācchādayan ata eva sudṛśīkarūpaḥ*
> *suṣṭu darśanīyarūpaḥ puruvāro bahubhirṛtvigbhiryajamānairvarṇanīyaḥ sannadyaut | dyotate |*
> *kimiva | rāyāśvādidhanena kṣitirna rājādiriva | kṣitiriti manuṣyanāma ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: of the one being kindled (samidhānasya, "kindled"), of the vṛṣṇaḥ, the showerer of fruit, of vasoḥ, the one who causes dwellings, of this Agni the anīkam, the mass of radiance, has shone all round (ā ruroca) in the dama, the house of sacrifice. For what purpose? श्रिये (*śriye*), for the welfare of the sacrificers. That Agni is ruśat (this is a name for colour), clothing himself, covering himself, in bright radiance; hence he is sudṛśīkarūpaḥ, of beautiful form; and puruvāraḥ, to be chosen by many priests and sacrificers; he shone (adyaut, "shines"). Like what? Like a kṣiti, a king or the like with rāyā, wealth such as horses. Kṣiti is a name for man.

Word-to-word meaning

- समिधानस्य (*samidhānasya*)—who is kindled by fuel-sticks
- वृष्णः (*vṛṣṇaḥ*)—who showers desires
- वसोः (*vasoḥ*)—who provides dwellings
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Agni
- अनेकं (*anekaṃ*)—the mass of radiances[?414]
- दमे (*dame*)—in this house of sacrifice
- श्रिये (*śriye*)—for the welfare (of the sacrificer)
- आ रुरोच (*ā ruroca*)—shines all round
- रुशत् (*ruśat*)—bright radiance
- वसानः (*vasānaḥ*)—who wears
- सुदृशीकरूपः (*sudṛśīkarūpaḥ*)—who has a beautiful form
- पुरुवारः (*puruvāraḥ*)—who is worshipped by many
- राया (*rāyā*)—who shines with wealth
- क्षितिर्न (*kṣitirna*)—like a king
- अद्यात् (*adyāt*)—he shines

Gist

The mass of radiances of Agni, who is kindled by fuel-sticks, who showers desires and provides dwellings, shines all round in this house of sacrifice for the welfare of the sacrificer. Agni, who wears bright radiance, has a beautiful form and is worshipped by many, shines like a king who shines with wealth.

English translation

For the prosperity of this (institutor of the rite), the host (of the flames) of the kindled (Agni), the showerer (of benefits), the giver of dwell-ings, has blazed in the hall (of sacrifice); clothed in radiance, beatiful in semblance, and glorified by many, he shines like a man with opulence.

Sūkta 6 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> ऊर्ध्व ऊ षु ण इत्येकादशर्चं षष्ठं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभमाग्नेयं । ऊर्ध्व ऊ श्वेकादशेत्यनुक्रांतं ॥ प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोराग्नेये क्रत्ौ त्रैष्टुभे छंदसीदं । सूत्रितं च । ऊर्ध्व ऊ षु णः ससस्य यद्वियुतेति पंच । आ. ४–१३ । इति ॥

> *ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇa ityekādaśarcaṃ ṣaṣṭhaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhamāgneyaṃ | ūrdhva ū śvekādaśetyanukrāṃtaṃ || prātaranuvākāśinaśastrayorāgneye kratau traiṣṭubhe chaṃdasīdaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇaḥ sasasya yadviyuteti paṃca | ā. 4-13 | iti ||*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Sāyaṇa says: the sixth sūkta, of eleven Ṛks, beginning ऊर्ध्व ऊ षु णः (*ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇaḥ*), has Vāmadeva as seer, Agni as deity and Triṣṭubh as metre. The Anukramaṇī says "ūrdhva ū ekādaśa". Its use is in the Prātaranuvāka and the Āśvina-śastra, in the Āgneya Kratu, for the verses in Triṣṭubh metre. It is stated in the sūtra: ऊर्ध्व ऊ षु णः ससस्य यद्वियुतेति पंच (*ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇaḥ sasasya yadviyuteti paṃca*) (Ā. 4-13).

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning "Ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇaḥ" is the sixth sūkta in the first anuvāka. It has eleven Ṛks. Vāmadeva is the seer of this sūkta; Agni is the deity; the metre is Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇī says "Ūrdhva ū" for it. It is explained by the Āśvalāyana-śrauta sūtra (Ā. 4-13) "Ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇaḥ, sasasya yad viyuta, these five": the sūkta is applied, at the time of reciting the Prātaranuvāka and the Āśvina-śastra mantras, for the Ṛks in Triṣṭubh metre among the mantras connected with the Āgneya Kratu.

Particulars

- Sūkta: 6
- Maṇḍala: 4; Anuvāka: 1; Sūkta: 6
- Aṣṭaka: 3; Adhyāya: 5; Varga: 4, 5
- Number of Ṛks in the sūkta: 11

- Ṛṣi: Vāmadeva
- Devatā: Agni
- Chandas: Triṣṭubh

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऊ॒र्ध्व ऊ॒ षु णो॑ अध्वरस्य होत॒रग्ने॒ तिष्ठ॑ दे॒वता॑ता॒ यजी॑यान् ।
त्वं हि विश्व॑म॒भ्यसि॒ मन्म॒ प्र वे॒धस॑श्चित्तिरसि मनी॒षाम् ॥ १ ॥

> *ūrdhva ū ṣu ṇo adhvarasya hotaragne tiṣṭha devatātā yajīyān |*
> *tvaṃ hi viśvamabhyasi manma pra vedhasaścittirasi manīṣām ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऊर्ध्वः । ऊं इति । सु । नः । अध्वरस्य । होतः । अग्ने । तिष्ठ । देवताता । यजीयान् ॥
> त्वं । हि । विश्वं । अभि । असि । मन्म । प्र । वेधसः । चित् । तिरसि । मनीषां ॥ १ ॥

> *ūrdhvaḥ | ūṃ iti | su | naḥ | adhvarasya | hotaḥ | agne | tiṣṭha | devatātā | yajīyān ‖*
> *tvaṃ | hi | viśvaṃ | abhi | asi | manma | pra | vedhasaḥ | cit | tirasi | manīṣāṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अध्वरस्य होतर्यागसंबंधिनां देवानामाह्वातः । यद्वा । होतरित्यत्र
> प्रकृत्यंशोऽनुवादः । हे होमनिष्पादकाग्ने यजीयान्यष्टृतमस्तुं नोऽस्माकमूर्ध्व ऊ पु तिष्ठ ।
> उन्नत एव तिष्ठ । नित्यमुन्नतो भवेत्यर्थः । कुत्रेति तदुच्यते । देवताता देवतात् । देवास्तायंते
> विस्तीर्यंतेऽत्रेति देवतातिर्यज्ञः ।
> तस्मिन् । त्वं हि त्वं खलु विश्वं सर्वं मन्म मननीयं शत्रूणां धनमभ्यसि । अभिभवसि।
> किंच वेधसश्चित् । चित्तूजायां । स्तोतुर्यजमानादेर्मनीषां मतिं स्तुतिं प्र
> तिरसि । प्रवर्धयसि । प्रपूर्वस्ति रतिर्वर्धनार्थः ॥

> *he adhvarasya hotaryāgasaṃbaṃdhināṃ devānāmāhvātaḥ | yadvā |*
> *hotarityatra*
> *prakṛtyaṃśo 'nuvādaḥ | he homaniṣpādakāgne yajīyānyaṣṭṛtamastuṃ no*
> *'smākamūrdhva ū pu tiṣṭha | unnata eva tiṣṭha | nityamunnato*
> *bhavetyarthaḥ | kutreti taducyate | devatātā devatāt | devāstāyaṃte*
> *vistīryaṃte 'treti devatātiryajñaḥ |*
> *tasmin | tvaṃ hi tvaṃ khalu viśvaṃ sarvaṃ manma mananīyaṃ*
> *śatrūṇāṃ dhanamabhyasi | abhibhavasi|*
> *kiṃca vedhasaścit | cittūjāyāṃ | stoturyajamānādermanīṣāṃ matiṃ*
> *stutiṃ pra*
> *tirasi | pravardhayasi | prapūrvasti ratirvardhanārthaḥ ||*

Summary

"O Hotṛ of the sacrifice": the summoner of the gods connected with the rite. Or else, in होतः (*hotaḥ*) the stem part is only a restatement. O Agni, accomplisher of the oblation, most excellent worshipper, stand erect for us, stand up high; that is, be ever exalted. Where? देवताता (*devatātā*) means देवताता (*devatātā*), in the sacrifice. The sacrifice is called देवतातिं (*devatātiṃ*) because the gods are spread out, extended, in it. In it you indeed overcome all that is to be thought on (मन्म (*manma*)), the wealth of enemies. Further, you promote the thought (मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*)), the praise, of the wise (वेधसः (*vedhasaḥ*)) praiser, the sacrificer and others; प्र तिरसि (*pra tirasi*) means "you make it grow", the root तिर (*tira*) with प्र (*pra*) having the sense of increase.[?415]

Word-to-word meaning

- अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)—of the sacrifice
- होतः (*hotaḥ*)—O Hotṛ
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यजीयान् (*yajīyān*)—you, the most worshipful
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- ऊर्ध्वः (*ūrdhvaḥ*)—being above
- ऊ षु तिष्ठ (*ū ṣu tiṣṭha*)—occupy the high place
- देवताता (*devatātā*)—in this sacrifice that worships the gods
- त्वं हि (*tvaṃ hi*)—you alone
- विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)—all

- मन्म (*manma*)—and what is to be thought on, the wealth
- अभि असि (*abhi asi*)—you are able to obtain and give
- वेधसः चित् (*vedhasaḥ cit*)—even though the sacrificer is wise
- मनीषां (*manīṣām̐*)—his praise also
- प्र तिरसि (*pra tirasi*)—you cause it to grow abundantly

Gist

O Agni, Hotṛ of the sacrifice, you, the most worshipful, be above us and occupy the high place; in the sacrifice that worships the gods you alone can obtain and give all that is to be thought on, the wealth.

You can make the praise of the wise sacrificer grow as well.

English translation

Agni, ministrant of the sacrifice, you are entitled to worship ; be above us in this offering to the gods; for you prevail over all that is desirable ; you inspire the praise of the worshipper.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अमू॑रो॒ होता॒ न्य॑सादि वि॒क्ष्व१॒॑ग्निर्म॒न्द्रो वि॒दथे॑षु॒ प्रचे॑ताः ।
ऊ॒र्ध्वं भा॒नुं स॑वि॒तेवा॑श्रे॒न्मेते॑व धू॒मं स्त॑भाय॒दु॒प द्याम् ॥ २ ॥

> *amūro hotā nyasādi vikṣvagnirmandro vidatheṣu pracetāḥ |*
> *ūrdhvaṃ bhānuṃ savitevāśrenmeteva dhūmaṃ stabhāyadupa dyām ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अमूरः । होता । नि । असादि । विक्षु । अग्निः । मंद्रः । विदथेषु । प्रचेताः ॥
> ऊर्ध्वं । भानुं । सविताइव । अश्रेत् । मेताइव । धूमं । स्तुभायत् । उप ।
> द्यां ॥ २ ॥

> *amūraḥ | hotā | ni | asādi | vikṣu | agniḥ | maṃdraḥ | vidatheṣu |*
> *pracetāḥ ‖*
> *ūrdhvaṃ | bhānuṃ | savitāiva | aśret | metāiva | dhūmaṃ | stubhāyat*
> *| upa |*
> *dyāṃ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अमूरोऽमूढः । प्रगल्भ इत्यर्थः । होता होमनिष्पादको मंद्रो
> मदनीयो मादयिता वा प्रचेताः प्रकृष्टज्ञानोऽग्निर्देवो विक्षृतिग्रूपासु
> प्रजासु मध्ये विदथेषु यागेषु निमित्तभूतेषु न्यसादि । नितरां स्थापितः । अथ
> तथाभूतोऽग्निर्भानुं दीप्तिं सवितेवोदितः सूर्य इवोृर्ध्वमश्रेत् । ऊर्ध्वमुखमाश्रयति । किंच मेतेव
> स्कूणेव । सा यथा स्वाधिष्ठितं वंशादिकं स्तभ्नाति
> तद्वयमुग्निर्धूमं स्वोत्थितं द्यामुप द्युलोकस्योपरि स्तभायत् । स्तभ्नाति ॥

> *amūro 'mūḍhaḥ | pragalbha ityarthaḥ | hotā homaniṣpādako maṃdro*
> *madanīyo mādayitā vā pracetāḥ prakṛṣṭajñāno 'gnirdevo vikṣṛtigrūpāsu*
> *prajāsu madhyè vidatheṣu yāgeṣu nimittabhūteṣu nyasādi | nitarāṃ*
> *sthāpitaḥ | atha*
> *tathābhūto 'gnirbhānuṃ dīptiṃ savitevoditaḥ sūrya ivorrdhvamaśret |*
> *ūrdhvamukhamāśrayati | kiṃca meteva skūṇeva | sā yathā*
> *svādhiṣṭhitaṃ vaṃśādikaṃ stabhnāti*
> *tadvayamugnirdhūmaṃ svotthitaṃ dyāmupa dyulokasyopari stabhāyat |*
> *stabhnāti ‖*

Summary

अमूरः (*amūraḥ*) is "undeluded", that is, bold. Agni, the god, the accomplisher of the oblation (होता (*hotā*)), delightful or delighting (मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*)), of excellent knowledge (प्रचेताः (*pracetāḥ*)), has been firmly set down among the people (विक्षु (*vikṣu*), the subjects) at the sacrifices (विदथेषु (*vidatheṣu*)) that are the occasion. Then, being such, Agni, like the risen sun, has raised his radiance (भानुं (*bhānuṃ*)) upward; he betakes himself upward. And like a post (मेता (*metā*)): as a post props bamboo and the like that is set upon it, so Agni props his own risen smoke above heaven, above the world of heaven.

Word-to-word meaning

- अमूरः (*amūraḥ*)—the discerning
- होता (*hotā*)—the accomplisher of the oblation
- मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*)—the attractive
- प्रचेताः (*pracetāḥ*)—and the one of excellent knowledge
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- विक्षु (*vikṣu*)—in the midst of us, the priests
- विदधेषु (*vidadheṣu*)—in the sacrificial house (for the sake of the sacrifice)
- न्यसादि (*nyasādi*)—has been established
- भानुं (*bhānuṃ*)—his light
- सवितेव (*saviteva*)—like the risen sun
- ऊर्ध्वं (*ūrdhvaṃ*)—upward
- अश्रेत् (*aśret*)—he has made to spread
- मेतेव (मेता इव) (*meteva (metā iva)*)—like a pillar
- धूमं (*dhūmaṃ*)—his mass of smoke
- द्यां उप (*dyāṃ upa*)—in the upper part of the atmosphere
- स्तभायत् (*stabhāyat*)—he has made to stand

Gist

Agni, the discerning, the accomplisher of the oblation, the attractive, the one of excellent knowledge, has been established among us priests in the sacrificial house for the sake of the sacrifice. Like the risen sun he has made his light spread upward. He has made his mass of smoke stand like a pillar in the upper part of the atmosphere.

English translation

The unperplexed, the sagacious, exhilarating Agni, the ministrant priest, has been placed amongst men for (the celebration of) sacrifices : like the sun, he spreads light above, and props the smoke above the sky like a pillar.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

य॒ता सु॑जू॒र्णी रा॒तिनी॑ घृ॒ताची॑ प्रदक्षि॒णिद्दे॒वता॑तिमुरा॒णः ।
उदु॒ स्वरु॑र्नव॒जा नाक्रः प॒श्वो अ॑नक्ति॒ सुधि॑तः सु॒मेक॑ः ॥ ३ ॥

> *yatā sujūrṇī rātinī ghṛtācī pradakṣiṇiddevatātimurāṇaḥ |*
> *udu svarurnavajā nākraḥ paśvo anakti sudhitaḥ sumekaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यता । सुजूर्णिः । रातिनी । घृताची । प्रदक्षिणित् । देवतातिं । उराणः ॥
> उत् । ऊं इति । स्वरुः । नवजाः । न । अक्रः । पश्वः । अनक्ति । सुधितः । सुमेकः ॥

> *yatā | sujūrṇiḥ | rātinī | ghṛtācī | pradakṣiṇit | devatātiṃ | urāṇaḥ ‖*
> *ut | ūṃ iti | svaruḥ | navajāḥ | na | akraḥ | paśvaḥ | anakti | sudhitaḥ | sumekaḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यता संयता सुजूर्णिः शोभनजवा सुष्टु जीर्णा पुराणी वा । धृताची
> धृतमंचतीति धृताची जुहूः । रातिनी । रातिर्धनं । हविर्लक्षणधनवती । आज्यपूर्णा
> भवतीत्यर्थः । देवतातिं यज्ञं तथोराण उरु कुर्वाणोऽध्वर्युरग्निर्वा प्रद–

> *yatā saṃyatā sujūrṇiḥ śobhanajavā suṣṭu jīrṇā purāṇī vā | dhṛtācī*
> *dhṛtamaṃcatīti dhṛtācī juhūḥ | rātinī | rātirdhanaṃ |*
> *havirlakṣaṇadhanavatī | ājyapūrṇā*
> *bhavatītyarthaḥ | devatātiṃ yajñaṃ tathorāṇa uru kurvāṇo*
> *'dhvaryuragnirvā prada-*

> क्षिणित् । प्रदक्षिणमेतीति प्रदक्षिणित् । प्रदक्षिणगमनो भवति ॥ अकारलोपश्रांदसः॥
> नवजा नवजातस्तदानीमेवोत्पादितः स्वरुर्न । यूपशकलवाची स्परुरत्र यूपं
> लक्षयति । चषालवंतः स्वरवः पृथिव्यां । ऋग्वे. ३–८–१० । इत्यादिषु स्वरुशब्देन
> यूपाभिधानाच्च । नकारः समुच्चये । यूपोऽप्युदु उपसर्गश्रुतेयोग्यक्रियाध्याहारः । उन्नतो भवति

> । किंच अक्र आक्रमिता । सुमेकः सुदीप्तः सुधितः
> स्वधितिरित्यर्थः । सोऽपि पश्वः पशूननक्ति । गच्छति । यद्वा । सुधितः स्वरुरेवोदु
> उत्कृष्टः पश्वः पशूननक्ति । स्वरुणा पशुमनक्तीति श्रुतेः ॥

> *kṣiṇit | pradakṣiṇametīti pradakṣiṇit | pradakṣiṇagamano bhavati ‖*
> *akāralopaśrāṃdasaḥ‖*
> *navajā navajātastadānīmevotpāditaḥ svarurna | yūpaśakalavācī sparuratra yūpaṃ*
> *lakṣayati | caṣālavaṃtaḥ svaravaḥ pṛthivyāṃ | ṛgve. 3-8-10 | ityādiṣu svaruśabdena*
> *yūpābhidhānācca | nakāraḥ samuccaye | yūpo 'pyudu*
> *upasargaśruteyogyakriyādhyāhāraḥ | unnato bhavati | kiṃca akra ākramitā | sumekaḥ sudīptaḥ sudhitaḥ*
> *svadhitirityarthaḥ | so 'pi paśvaḥ paśūnanakti | gacchati | yadvā | sudhitaḥ svarurevodu*
> *utkṛṣṭaḥ paśvaḥ paśūnanakti | svaruṇā paśumanaktīti śruteḥ ‖*

Summary

यता (*yatā*) is "restrained"; सुजूर्णिः (*sujūrṇiḥ*) is "of fine speed", or "well worn", that is, old. धृताची (*dhṛtācī*): she that goes to (carries) ghee, the Juhū ladle. रातिनी (*rātinī*): *rātiḥ* is wealth; possessing the wealth that consists of the oblation, that is, she is full of ghee. The sacrifice (देवतातिं (*devatātiṃ*)) likewise the Adhvaryu, or Agni, making it wide (उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*)), goes round with the right side (प्रदक्षिणित् (*pradakṣiṇit*));

प्रदक्षिणित् (*pradakṣiṇit*) is one who goes keeping the right side toward it; the loss of the vowel a is Vedic. नवजा (*navajā*): newly born, produced just then, like a स्वरुः (*svaruḥ*). The word स्वरु (*svaru*) denotes a splinter of the sacrificial post and here points to the post, since in passages such as "the posts with their knobs on the earth" (Ṛgve. 3-8-10) the post is named by the word स्वरु (*svaru*). The particle न (*na*) is in the sense of conjunction: the post too stands up; the verb is to be supplied from the preposition उदु (*udu*) heard in the text, so that it means "becomes raised". Further, अक्रः (*akraḥ*) is the one that assails. सुमेकः (*sumekaḥ*) is well-shining; सुधितः (*sudhitaḥ*) is the axe (*svadhitiḥ*). It too goes (अनक्ति (*anakti*)) to the animals (पश्वः

(*paśvaḥ*)). Or else: the post (स्वरुः (*svaruḥ*)) itself, well placed, is excellent (उदु (*udu*)) and goes to the animals, according to the śruti "with the post he anoints the animal".?416

Word-to-word meaning

- यता (*yatā*)—the refined
- सुजूर्णिः (*sujūrṇiḥ*)—and the very ancient
- घृताची (*dhṛtācī*)—the Juhū vessel
- रातिनी (*rātinī*)—is filled with wealth in the form of the oblation
- देवतातिं (*devatātiṃ*)—the sacrifice that worships the gods
- उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*)—the Adhvaryus who perform
- प्रदक्षिणित् (*pradakṣiṇit*)—are offering homage, keeping the right side toward it
- नवजाः (*navajāḥ*)—newly produced
- स्वरुः न (*svaruḥ na*)—the sacrificial post also
- उदु (*udu*)—stands raised
- अक्रः (*akraḥ*)—the one that assails the animal
- सुमेकः (*sumekaḥ*)—the shining
- सुधितः (*sudhitaḥ*)—the weapon that is the instrument of slaughter
- पश्वः (*paśvaḥ*)—the animals
- अनक्ति (*anakti*)—is approaching

Gist

The well-refined, very ancient Juhū vessel is filled with wealth in the form of the oblation. The Adhvaryus who perform the sacrifice honoured by the gods offer homage, keeping the right side toward it. The newly produced sacrificial post too stands raised. The weapon that assails the animal, shining, the instrument of slaughter, approaches the animals.

English translation

The ladle filled (with butter) is prepared : prompt (in act), opulent (with the oblation), the multiplying (priest), conducting (the worship) of the gods, circumambulates (the fire): the newly-trimmed post is set up, the impending shining axe falls upon the victims

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्ती॒र्णे ब॒र्हिषि॑ समिधा॒ने अ॒ग्ना ऊ॒र्ध्वो अ॑ध्व॒र्युर्जु॑जुषा॒णो अ॑स्थात् ।
पर्य॒ग्निः प॑शु॒पा न होता॑ त्रिवि॒ष्ट्ये॑ति प्र॒दिव॑ उरा॒णः ॥ ४ ॥

> *stīrṇe barhiṣi samidhāne agnā ūrdhvo adhvaryurjujuṣāṇo asthāt |*
> *paryagniḥ paśupā na hotā triviṣṭyeti pradiva urāṇaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्त्रीणे । बर्हिषि । संइधाने । अग्नौ । ऊर्ध्वः । अध्वर्युः । जुजुषाणः । अस्थात् ।
> परि । अग्निः । पशुपाः । न । होता । त्रिविष्टि । एति । प्रदिवः । उराणः ॥ ४ ॥

> *strīṇe | barhiṣi | saṃidhāne | agnau | ūrdhvaḥ | adhvaryuḥ | jujuṣāṇaḥ | asthāt |*
> *pari | agniḥ | paśupāḥ | na | hotā | triviṣṭi | eti | pradivaḥ | urāṇaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> बर्हिषि वेद्यां स्तिर्ण आस्तृते सत्यग्नावाहवनीयादिके समिधाने सम्यगिध्यमाने च
> सत्यध्वर्युरध्वरस्य नेता जुजुषाणो देवान्प्रीणयन्नोध्वोऽस्थात् ।
> तिष्ठति । होता होमनिष्पादकः प्रदिवः । पुराणनामैतत् । पुरातन उराणः स्वल्पमपि
> हविर्देवयोग्यत्वसंपादनेनोरु कुर्वाणः । उराण उरु कुर्वाण इति
> निरुक्तं । यद्वै देवैर्जोष्यते हविस्तद्विरिमात्रं वर्धत इति श्रुतेरग्नेरुरुकरणमुचितं । ईदृशोग्निः
> पशुपा न पशूनां पालक इव पशून् त्रिविष्टि त्रिरावृत्य
> पर्येति त्रिर्हि पर्याग्निः क्रियते ॥

> *barhiṣi vedyāṃ stirṇa āstṛte satyagnāvāhavanīyādike samidhāne*
> *samyagidhyamāne ca satyadhvaryuradhvarasya netā jujuṣāṇo*
> *devānprīṇayannodhvo 'sthāt |*
> *tiṣṭhati | hotā homaniṣpādakaḥ pradivaḥ | purāṇanāmaitat | purātana*
> *urāṇaḥ svalpamapi havirdevayogyatvasaṃpādanenoru kurvāṇaḥ |*

> *urāṇa uru kurvāṇa iti*
> *niruktaṃ | yadvai devairjoṣyate havistaddirimātraṃ vardhata iti*
> *śruteragnerurukaraṇamucitaṃ | īdṛśogniḥ paśupā na paśūnāṃ pālaka*
> *iva paśūn triviṣṭi trirāvṛtya*
> *paryèti trirhi paryāgniḥ kriyate* ‖

Summary

When the barhis is strewn (स्तीर्णे (*stīrṇe*)) on the vedi, and the fires, the Āhavanīya and the others, are well kindled, the Adhvaryu, the leader of the sacrifice, pleasing the gods (जुजुषाणः (*jujuṣāṇaḥ*)), stands up erect (अस्थात् (*asthāt*)). The Hotṛ, the accomplisher of the oblation, is प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*) (a name meaning "ancient"), the ancient one; उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*) is one who makes even a little oblation wide by making it fit for the gods. "उराण (*urāṇa*) is making wide", says the Nirukta. According to the śruti "whatever oblation is enjoyed by the gods, that grows though only a trifle", this making wide is proper to Agni. Such an Agni goes round the animals thrice (त्रिविष्टि (*triviṣṭi*)), repeating three times, like a herdsman (पशुपा न (*paśupā na*)), for the fire is carried round three times.

Word-to-word meaning

- बर्हिषि (*barhiṣi*)—the seats of darbha grass
- स्तीर्णे (*stīrṇe*)—being spread
- अग्नौ (*agnau*)—when Agni in the form of the Āhavanīya
- समिधाने (*samidhāne*)—is kindled
- अध्वर्युः (*adhvaryuḥ*)—the leader of the sacrifice
- जुजुषाणः (*jujuṣāṇaḥ*)—the one who satisfies the gods, the Adhvaryu (or Agni)
- ऊर्ध्वः (*ūrdhvaḥ*)—upward-facing
- अस्थात् (*asthāt*)—rises and stands
- होता (*hotā*)—the accomplisher of the oblation
- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—the ancient
- उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*)—the promoter of the growth of the sacrifice
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- पशुपा न (*paśupā na*)—like a keeper of animals
- त्रिविष्टि (*triviṣṭi*)—three times

- परि एति (*pari eti*)—goes round

Gist

When the seats of darbha grass are spread on the sacrificial altar and Agni in the form of the Āhavanīya is kindled, the Adhvaryu, the leader of the sacrifice, who satisfies the gods, rises and stands upward-facing. Agni, the accomplisher of the oblation, the ancient, the promoter of the growth of the sacrifice, goes round three times like a keeper of animals.

English translation

When the sacred grass is strewn and the fire is kindled, the Adhwaryu rises, propitiating (the gods), and Agni, the offerer of the oblation, ancient and multiplying (the offering), thrice circumambulates (the victim) like a keeper of cattle.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

परि॒ त्मना॑ मि॒तद्रु॑रेति॒ होता॒ग्निर्म॒न्द्रो मधु॑वचा ऋ॒तावा॑ ।
द्रव॑न्त्यस्य वा॒जिनो॒ न शोका॒ भय॑न्ते॒ विश्वा॒ भुव॑ना॒ यदभ्रा॑ट् ॥ ५ ॥

> *pari tmanā mitadrureti hotāgnirmandro madhuvacā ṛtāvā |*
> *dravantyasya vājino na śokā bhayante viśvā bhuvanā yadabhrāṭ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परि । त्मना । मितद्रुः । एति । होता । अग्निः । मंद्रः । मधुवचाः । ऋतवा ।
> द्रवंति । अस्य । वाजिनः । न । शोकाः । भयंते । विश्वा । भुवना । यत् । अभ्राट् ॥

> *pari | tmanā | mitadruḥ | eti | hotā | agniḥ | maṃdraḥ | madhuvacāḥ | ṛtavā |*
> *dravaṃti | asya | vājinaḥ | na | śokāḥ | bhayaṃte | viśvā | bhuvanā | yat | abhrāṭ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उक्तमेवार्थं स्पष्टयति । अयं होता होमनिष्पादकोऽग्निस्त्मनात्मना
> स्वरूपेणैव मितद्रुः परिमितगतिः सन् पर्येति । परितो गच्छति पशुं । कीदृशोऽयं । मुंद्रो
> मादनीयो मोदयिता वा मधुवचा मधुरवचन ऋतावा
> यज्ञवान् । वाजिनो हविष्कृतोऽस्याग्नेः शोका न दीप्तयोऽपि । नशब्दोऽप्यर्थे ।
> द्रवंति । गच्छंति परितः । यद्वा । नकार उपमार्थीयः । वाजिनो न अश्वा इव
> द्रवंतीति योज्यं । यद्यस्मादयमभ्राट् । भ्राजते । तस्माद्विश्वा भुवना सर्वाणि
> भूतजातानि भयंते । भीतानि भवंति ॥

> *uktamevārthaṃ spaṣṭayati | ayaṃ hotā homaniṣpādako 'gnistmanātmanā*
> *svarūpeṇaiva mitadruḥ parimitagatiḥ san paryèti | parito gacchati paśuṃ | kīdṛśo 'yaṃ | muṃdro mādanīyo modayitā vā madhuvacā madhuravacana ṛtāvā*
> *yajñavān | vājino haviṣkṛto 'syāgneḥ śokā na dīptayo 'pi | naśabdo 'pyarthe |*
> *dravaṃti | gacchaṃti paritaḥ | yadvā | nakāra upamārthīyaḥ | vājino na aśvā iva*
> *dravaṃtīti yojyaṃ | yadyasmādayamabhrāṭ | bhrājate | tasmādviśvā bhuvanā sarvāṇi*
> *bhūtajātāni bhayaṃte | bhītāni bhavaṃti ‖*

Summary

He makes clear the sense already stated. This Hotṛ, Agni the accomplisher of the oblation, goes round (पर्येति (*paryèti*)) the animal on every side by himself (त्मना (*tmanā*)), in his own form, moving at a measured pace (मितद्रुः (*mitadruḥ*)). What is he like? मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*): delightful or gladdening; मधुवचाः (*madhuvacāḥ*): of sweet speech; ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*): possessed of the sacrifice. The flames (शोकाः (*śokāḥ*)), the lights, of this Agni, who are bearers of the oblation (वाजिनः (*vājinaḥ*)), also run (द्रवंति (*dravaṃti*)), go, all around; the word न (*na*) has the sense of "also". Or else the न (*na*) is one of comparison, and it is to be construed "they run like horses (वाजिनो न (*vājino na*))". Because (यत् (*yat*)) he shines (अभ्राट् (*abhrāṭ*)), therefore all beings (विश्वा भुवना (*viśvā bhuvanā*)) fear (भयंते (*bhayaṃte*)), are afraid.

Word-to-word meaning

- होता (*hotā*)—the accomplisher of the oblation
- मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*)—the causer of joy
- मधुवचाः (*madhuvacāḥ*)—the one of sweet speech
- ऋताना (*ṛtānā*)—and the possessor of the sacrifice
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- त्मना (*tmanā*)—by his own free will [the Kannada text breaks off here]
- मितद्रुः (*mitadruḥ*)—moving with measured pace
- परि एति (*pari eti*)—goes round about
- वाजिनः (*vājinaḥ*)—of the one possessing oblations
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Agni
- शोकाः न (*śokāḥ na*)—the flames also
- द्रवंति (*dravaṃti*)—run round about
- यत् (*yat*)—by whose greatness
- अभ्राट् (*abhrāṭ*)—(because) this Agni shines
- विश्वा भुवना (*viśvā bhuvanā*)—all created beings also
- भयंते (*bhayaṃte*)—are frightened

Gist

Agni, the accomplisher of the offering, the gladdener, sweet of speech, possessor of the sacrifice, by his own free impulse moves round about with measured pace. The flames of this Agni, who possesses the oblation, also move round about. Because of the greatness by which this Agni shines, all created beings are frightened.

English translation

Agni, the sacrificer, the exhilarator, the sweet-spoken, the object of sacrifice, moving measuredly, circumambulates (the victim) of his own (accord); the bright (rays) of him (fed) with (sacrificial) food, spread around; all the regions are alarmed when he blazes.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

भ॒द्रा ते॑ अग्ने स्वनीक सं॒दृग्घो॒रस्य॑ स॒तो विषु॑ण
स्य॒ चारु॑ः ।
न यत्ते॑ शो॒चिस्तम॑सा॒ वर॑न्त॒ न ध्व॒स्मान॑स्त॒न्वी॒३॑ रे
प॒ आ धु॑ः ॥ ६ ॥

> *bhadrā te agne svanīka saṃdṛgghorasya sato viṣuṇasya cāruḥ |*
> *na yatte śocistamasā varanta na dhvasmānastanvī repa ā dhuḥ || 6 ||*

Pada-pāṭha

> भद्रा । ते । अग्ने । सुअनीक । संदृक् । घोरस्य । सतः । विषुणस्य । चारुः ।
> न । यत् । ते । शोचिः । तमसा । वरंत । न । ध्वस्मानः । तन्वि । रेपः । अ ।
> धुरितिधुः ॥ ६ ॥

> *bhadrā | te | agne | suanīka | saṃdṛk | ghorasya | sataḥ | viṣuṇasya |*
> *cāruḥ |*
> *na | yat | te | śociḥ | tamasā | varaṃta | na | dhvasmānaḥ | tanvi |*
> *repaḥ | a |*
> *dhuritidhuḥ || 6 ||*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे स्वनीक शोभनज्वालाग्ने घोरस्य भीतजनकस्यापि सतो विषुणस्य विश्वक्
> सर्वत्रो व्याप्तस्य ते तव चारू रमणीया भद्रा स्तुत्या कल्याणी ना मूर्तिः

> *he svanīka śobhanajvālāgne ghorasya bhītajanakasyāpi sato viṣuṇasya viśvak*
> *sarvatro vyāptasya te tava cārū ramaṇīyā bhadrā stutyā kalyāṇī nā mūrtiḥ*

> संदृक् संदृष्टिः । सम्यक् दृश्या भवतीत्यर्थः। यद्यस्मात्ते शोचिर्दिप्तिं तमसांधकारेण न वरंत । वारयंति निशाः । यस्माच्च ध्वस्मानो ध्वंसका राक्षसादयस्ते तन्नि
> तव शरीरे रेपः पापं ध्वंसनादिरूपं ना धुः । न दधति । न कुर्वंति । अतः सुदृगिति संबंधः ॥

> *saṃdṛk saṃdṛṣṭiḥ | samyak dṛśyā bhavatītyarthaḥ| yadyasmātte śocirdiptiṃ tamasāṃdhakāreṇa na varaṃta | vārayaṃti niśāḥ | yasmācca dhvasmāno dhvaṃsakā rākṣasādayaste tanni*
> *tava śarīre repaḥ pāpaṃ dhvaṃsanādirūpaṃ nā dhuḥ | na dadhati | na kurvaṃti | ataḥ sudṛgiti saṃbaṃdhaḥ ||*

Summary

O Agni of beautiful flame, though you are fearsome, being pervasive everywhere, your form is lovely, praiseworthy and auspicious (the sentence continues on the next page).

Your sight (संदृक् (*saṃdṛk*)) is well seen, that is, you are beautiful to behold. Because the nights do not cover your radiance with darkness, and because destroyers, the Rākṣasas and the like, do not inflict on your body any harm of the nature of destruction, therefore the construction is "of beautiful sight."

Word-to-word meaning

- स्वनीक (*svanīka*)—you of auspicious flame
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यत् (*yat*)—by which greatness of yours
- ते (*te*)—your
- शोचिः (*śociḥ*)—radiance
- निशा (*niśā*)—the night
- तमसा (*tamasā*)—with darkness
- न वरंत (*na varaṃta*)—is not covered
- ध्वस्मानः (*dhvasmānaḥ*)—the destroying Rākṣasas
- तन्नि (*tanni*)—in your body
- रेपः (*repaḥ*)—the destructive act of injury

- न आधुः (*na ādhuḥ*)—cannot do (because of that)
- घोरस्य सतः (*ghorasya sataḥ*)—being fear-inspiring
- विषुणस्य (*viṣuṇasya*)—and pervading everywhere
- ते (*te*)—your
- संदृक् (*saṃdṛk*)—sight
- चारुः (*cāruḥ*)—is lovely
- भद्रा (*bhadrā*)—and auspicious

Gist

O Agni of auspicious flame, by whose greatness the night cannot cover your radiance with darkness and the destroying Rākṣasas cannot do their destructive act of injury to you, for that very reason your sight, though fear-inspiring and all-pervading, is lovely and auspicious.

English translation

Bright-shining Agni, beautiful and auspicious is the semblance of you, who are terrible and wide-spreading, for (the nights) hide not your splendour with darkness, nor do the malignant (spirits) inflict any injury on your person.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

न यस्य॒ सातु॒र्जनि॑तो॒रवा॑रि॒ न मा॒तरा॑पि॒तरा॒ नू चि॑दि॒ष्टौ ।
अधा॑ मि॒त्रो न सुधि॑तः पाव॒को॒३॒॑ऽग्निर्दी॑दाय॒ मानु॑षीषु वि॒क्षु ॥ ७ ॥

> *na yasya sāturjanitoravāri na mātarāpitarā nū cidiṣṭau |*
> *adhā mitro na sudhitaḥ pāvako 'gnirdīdāya mānuṣīṣu vikṣu ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> न । यस्य । सातुः । जनितोः । अनारि । न । मातरा । पितरा । नु । चित् । इष्टौ ।
> अध । मित्रः । न । सुधितः । पावकः । अग्निः । दीदाय । मानुषीषु । विक्षु ॥ ७ ॥

> *na | yasya | sātuḥ | janitoḥ | anāri | na | mātarā | pitarā | nu | cit | iṣṭau |*
> *adha | mitraḥ | na | sudhitaḥ | pāvakaḥ | agniḥ | dīdāya | mānuṣīṣu | vikṣu ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> जनितोर्जनयितुर्वृष्टुत्पादकस्य यस्य वैश्वानरस्य सातुः सनिः पश्वादिलक्षणं
> दानं दीप्तिर्वा नावारि । केनापि न वार्यते । किंच मातरा पितरा मातापितरौ
> द्यावापृथिव्यौ यस्यॆष्टौ प्रेषणे नू चित् क्षिप्रमेव न प्रभवतः । अधापि च मित्रो
> न सखेव सुधितः सुतृप्तः पावकः शोधकोग्निर्मानुषीषु मनोः संबंधिनीषु
> विक्षु प्रजासु दीदाय । दीप्यते ॥ दीपी दीप्ता । पकारलोपश्छांदसः । व्यत्ययेन
> परस्मैपदं । लिट्यभ्यासस्य ह्रस्वे कृते तुजादित्वाद्दीर्घत्वं ॥

> *janitorjanayiturvṛṣṭutpādakasya yasya vaiśvānarasya sātuḥ saniḥ paśvādilakṣaṇaṃ*
> *dānaṃ dīptirvā nāvāri | kenāpi na vāryate | kiṃca mātarā pitarā mātāpitarau*
> *dyāvāpṛthivyau yasyèṣṭau preṣaṇe nū cit kṣiprameva na prabhavataḥ | adhāpi ca mitro*
> *na sakheva sudhitaḥ sutṛptaḥ pāvakaḥ śodhakognirmānuṣīṣu manoḥ saṃbaṃdhinīṣu*
> *vikṣu prajāsu dīdāya | dīpyate ‖ dīpī dīptā | pakāralopaścāṃdasaḥ | vyatyayena*
> *parasmaipadaṃ | liṭyabhyāsasya hrasve kṛte tujāditvāddīrghatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

Of Vaiśvānara, the progenitor, the producer of rain, whose giving (सातुः (*sātuḥ*)) of cattle and the like, or whose radiance, is not checked by anyone. Moreover, Heaven and Earth, the mother and father, are not able to act quickly when he is to be sent forth. And Agni, the purifier, well satisfied like a friend, shines among the human creatures, the peoples belonging to Manu. Grammar remarks: दीदाय (*dīdāya*) is from the root dīp, with loss of p being Vedic, parasmaipada by interchange.

Word-to-word meaning

- जनितोः (*janitoḥ*)—of the producer of rain
- यस्य (*yasya*)—of that Vaiśvānara
- सातुः (*sātuḥ*)—the giving (or radiance)
- न अवारि (*na avāri*)—cannot be checked by anyone
- मातारा पितरा (*mātārā pitarā*)—Heaven and Earth, mother and father of the world
- इष्टौ (*iṣṭau*)—in the act of sending forth Agni
- नू चित् (*nū cit*)—quickly
- न (*na*)—are not able
- अध (*adha*)—and
- मित्रः न (*mitraḥ na*)—like a friend
- सुधितः (*sudhitaḥ*)—satisfied
- पावकः (*pāvakaḥ*)—purifier
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- मानुषीषु (*mānuṣīṣu*)—in human
- निक्षु (*nikṣu*)—among the peoples[?418]
- दीदाय (*dīdāya*)—shines

Gist

The radiance of Vaiśvānara, the producer of rain, cannot be checked by anyone. Even Heaven and Earth, the mother and father of the world, are not quickly able in the act of sending Agni forth. Agni, satisfied like a friend and a purifier, shines among the peoples of human form.

English translation

Of whom, progenitor (of mankind), the benevolence is never checked ; whose parents need not urge him to exertion ; so that the well-satisfied, puri-fying Agni shines like a friend amongst men, the descendants of Manu

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

द्विर्यं पञ्च॒ जीज॑नन्सं॒वसा॑ना॒ः स्वसा॑रो अ॒ग्निं मानु॑षीषु वि॒क्षु ।
उ॒ष॒र्बुध॑मथ॒र्यो॒३॑ न दन्तं॑ शु॒क्रं स्वासं॑ पर॒शुं न ति॒ग्मम् ॥ ८ ॥

> *dviryaṃ pañca jījanansaṃvasānāḥ svasāro agniṃ mānuṣīṣu vikṣu |*
> *uṣarbudhamatharyo na dantaṃ śukraṃ svāsaṃ paraśuṃ na tigmam ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> द्विः । यं । पंच । जीजनन् । संवसानाः । स्वसारः । अग्निं । मानुषेषु । विक्षु ।
> उषःबुधं । अथर्यः । न । दंतं । शुक्रं । सुआसं । परशुं । न । तिग्मं ॥ ८ ॥

> *dviḥ | yaṃ | paṃca | jījanan | saṃvasānāḥ | svasāraḥ | agniṃ | mānuṣeṣu | vikṣu |*
> *uṣaḥbudhaṃ | atharyaḥ | na | daṃtaṃ | śukraṃ | suāsaṃ | paraśuṃ | na | tigmaṃ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मानुषीषु मनोः संबंधिनीषु विक्षु प्रजासु संवसानाः संगच्छमाना द्विः
> पंच दश स्वसारोऽंगुलयो यमग्निं जीजनन् । मंथनेनोदपादयन् ॥ जनी
> प्रादुर्भावे । लुजि छांदसत्वादडभावः ॥ कीदृश्य अंगुलयः । अथर्यो न स्त्रिय
> इव । कीदृशमग्निं । उषर्बुधमुषसि बुध्यमानं दंतं हविषां भक्षकं शुक्रं रश्मिभिर्दीप्यमानं स्नासं
> शोभनास्यं तिग्मं तीक्ष्णं परशुं न परशुमिव रक्षसां हंतारमिति शेषः ॥

> *mānuṣīṣu manoḥ saṃbaṃdhinīṣu vikṣu prajāsu saṃvasānāḥ saṃgacchamānā dviḥ*
> *paṃca daśa svasāro 'ṃgulayo yamagniṃ jījanan |*
> *maṃthanenodapādayan ‖ janī*
> *prādurbhāve | luji chāṃdasatvādaḍabhāvaḥ ‖ kīdṛśya aṃgulayaḥ |*
> *atharyo na striya*

> *iva | kīdṛśamagniṃ | uṣarbudhamuṣasi budhyamānaṃ daṃtaṃ haviṣāṃ bhakṣakaṃ śukraṃ raśmibhirdīpyamānaṃ snāsaṃ śobhanāsyaṃ tigmaṃ tīkṣṇaṃ paraśuṃ na paraśumiva rakṣasāṃ haṃtāramiti śeṣaḥ ||*

Summary

The ten sisters, the fingers, dwelling together among human peoples belonging to Manu, engendered Agni by churning (जीजनन् (*jījanan*) from jan, "to appear"; the loss of the augment a is Vedic). What sort of fingers? Like women. What sort of Agni? Awakening at dawn, the eater of oblations, bright, shining with rays, of beautiful mouth, sharp like an axe, that is, the slayer of Rākṣasas (this being the supplied remainder).

Word-to-word meaning

- मानुषीषु (*mānuṣīṣu*)—belonging to Manu
- विक्षु (*vikṣu*)—among the peoples
- सं वसानाः (*saṃ vasānāḥ*)—joined together
- द्विः पंच (*dviḥ paṃca*)—ten in number
- अथर्यः न (*atharyaḥ na*)—like women
- स्वसारः (*svasāraḥ*)—the fingers
- उषर्बुधं (*uṣarbudhaṃ*)—him who becomes visible at dawn
- दंतं (*daṃtaṃ*)—the eater of oblation
- शुक्रं(*śukraṃ*)—the shining
- स्वासं (*svāsaṃ*)—of radiant face
- तिग्मं (*tigmaṃ*)—sharp
- परशुं न (*paraśuṃ na*)—like an axe, the destroyer of Rākṣasas
- यं (*yaṃ*)—which same Agni
- जीजनन् (*jījanan*)—they produced

Gist

The fingers, ten in number, joined together among the peoples belonging to Manu and like women, produced Agni, who becomes visible at dawn, eats the oblation, is shining, of radiant face, and destroys the Rākṣasas like a sharp axe.

English translation

Agni, whom the twice five sisters dwelling amongst men, the descendants of Manu, have engendered, like females, (awaking) him at dawn, feeding on oblations, brilliant, of goodly aspect, and sharp as an axe.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तव॒ त्ये अ॑ग्ने ह॒रितो॑ घृत॒स्ना रोहि॑तास ऋ॒ज्वञ्च॒ः स्वञ्च॑ः ।
अ॒रु॒षासो॒ वृष॑ण ऋजुमु॒ष्का आ दे॒वता॑तिमह्वन्त द॒स्माः ॥ ९ ॥

> *tava tye agne harito ghṛtasnā rohitāsa ṛjvañcaḥ svañcaḥ |*
> *aruṣāso vṛṣaṇa ṛjumuṣkā ā devatātimahvanta dasmāḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तव । त्ये । अग्ने । हरितः । धृतस्नाः । रोहितासः । ऋजुअंचः । सुअंचः ।
> अरुषासः । वृषणः । ऋजुमुष्काः । आ । देव्यतातिं । अह्वंत । दस्माः ॥ ९ ॥

> *tava | tye | agne | haritaḥ | dhṛtasnāḥ | rohitāsaḥ | ṛjuaṃcaḥ | suaṃcaḥ |*
> *aruṣāsaḥ | vṛṣaṇaḥ | ṛjumuṣkāḥ | ā | devyatātiṃ | ahvaṃta | dasmāḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने त्ये ते प्रसिद्धास्तव हरितस्त्वत्संबंधिनोऽश्वा देवतातिमस्मदीयं यागं प्रत्याह्वंत । ऋत्विभिराहूयंते ॥ लुजु लिपिसिचिश्वश्चेत्यजादेशः ॥ कीवृशाः । धृतस्ना धृतस्न्नुवो बलातिशयान्नासापुटादिस्थानेभ्य उदकं क्षरंतो रोहितासो रोहिता लोहितवर्णा ऋज्ञंचः । ऋज्ञकुटिलमंचंति गच्छंतीत्यृज्ञंचः । स्वंच सुष्टु गच्छंतः । अरुषास आरोचमाना वृषणो युवानो वर्षितारो वा ॥ वा षपूर्वस्य निगम इति विकल्पेन दीर्घविधानादत्र दीर्घाभावः ॥ ऋजुमुष्काः साधनमुष्का दस्मा दर्शनीयाः ॥

> *he agne tye te prasiddhāstava haritastvatsaṃbaṃdhino 'śvā devatātimasmadīyaṃ*
> *yāgaṃ pratyāhvaṃta | ṛtvibhirāhūyaṃte ‖ luju lipisiciśvaścetyajādeśaḥ ‖ kīvṛśāḥ |*
> *dhṛtasnā dhṛtasnnuvo balātiśayānnāsāpuṭādisthānebhya udakaṃ kṣaraṃto rohitāso*
> *rohitā lohitavarṇā ṛjjaṃcaḥ | ṛjjakuṭilamaṃcaṃti gacchaṃtītyṛjjaṃcaḥ | svaṃca*
> *suṣṭu gacchaṃtaḥ | aruṣāsa ārocamānā vṛṣaṇo yuvāno varṣitāro vā ‖ vā ṣapūrvasya nigama iti vikalpena dīrghavidhānādatra dīrghābhāvaḥ ‖*
> *ṛjumuṣkāḥ sādhanamuṣkā dasmā darśanīyāḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, those well-known horses of yours are summoned by the priests to our sacrifice (अह्वंत (*ahvaṃta*); the substitution aja by the sūtra on lu). Of what sort? धृतस्नाः (*dhṛtasnāḥ*): through excess of strength they let water flow from the nostrils and other places. रोहितासः (*rohitāsaḥ*): red-coloured. ऋज्जंचः (*ṛjjaṃcaḥ*): going straight (not crooked). स्वंचः (*svaṃcaḥ*): going well. अरुषासः (*aruṣāsaḥ*): shining. वृषणः (*vṛṣaṇaḥ*): young, or showerers; because the lengthening is optional, no lengthening occurs here. ऋजुमुष्काः (*ṛjumuṣkāḥ*): of effective strength; दस्माः (*dasmāḥ*): beautiful to see.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- तव (*tava*)—your
- त्यै (*tyai*)—well-known
- धृतस्नाः (*dhṛtasnāḥ*)—pouring out foam
- रोहितासः (*rohitāsaḥ*)—golden-coloured
- ऋज्जंचः (*ṛjjaṃcaḥ*)—of straight gait
- स्वंच (*svaṃca*)—moving excellently
- अरुषासः (*aruṣāsaḥ*)—golden-coloured
- वृषणः (*vṛṣaṇaḥ*)—endowed with youth
- ऋजुमुष्काः (*ṛjumuṣkāḥ*)—of excellent limbs
- दस्माः (*dasmāḥ*)—of attractive look
- हरितः (*haritaḥ*)—the horses

- देवतातिं (*devatātiṃ*)—to the sacrifice that worships the gods
- आ अह्वंत (*ā ahvaṃta*)—are called

Gist

O Agni, your well-known horses, pouring out foam, golden, of straight gait, moving excellently, golden, youthful, of excellent limbs, of attractive look, are summoned to the sacrifice that worships the gods.

English translation

Your horses, Agni, breathing foam, red-coloured, straight-going, well-paced, bright-shining, vigorous, well-membered, and of graceful form, are summoned to the worship of the gods.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ये ह॒ त्ये ते॒ सह॑माना अ॒यासं॑स्त्वे॒षासो॑ अग्ने अ॒र्चय॒
श्चरं॑न्ति ।
श्ये॒नासो॒ न दुं॑वस॒नासो॒ अर्थं॑ तुविष्व॒णसो॒ मारुं॑तं॒
न शर्धं॑◌ः ॥ १० ॥

> *ye ha tye te sahamānā ayāsastveṣāso agne arcayaścaranti |*
> *śyenāso na duvasanāso arthaṃ tuviṣvaṇaso mārutaṃ na śardhaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ये । ह । त्ये । ते । सहमानाः । अयासः । त्वेषासः । अग्ने । अर्चयः । चरंति ।
> श्येनासः । न । दुवसनासः । अर्थं । तुविस्वनसः । मारुतं । न । शर्धः ॥ १० ॥

> *ye | ha | tye | te | sahamānāḥ | ayāsaḥ | tveṣāsaḥ | agne | arcayaḥ | caraṃti |*
> *śyenāsaḥ | na | duvasanāsaḥ | arthaṃ | tuvisvanasaḥ | mārutaṃ | na | śardhaḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ये ह खलु त्ये ते प्रसिद्धाः सहमानाः शत्रूनभिभवंतोऽयासो
> गमनशीलास्त्वेषासो दीप्ता दुवसनासः परिचरणीयास्ते त्वदीया अर्चयो
> रश्मयः श्येनासो न अश्वा इवार्थं गंतव्यं चरंति । गच्छंति । कीदृशाः । मारुतं
> शर्धो न मरुत्संबंधी गण इव तुविष्टणसस्तुविस्वना अधिकध्वनयो भवंति ॥

> *he agne ye ha khalu tye te prasiddhāḥ sahamānāḥ śatrūnabhibhavaṃto 'yāso*
> *gamanaśīlāstveṣāso dīptā duvasanāsaḥ paricaraṇīyāste tvadīyā arcayo*
> *raśmayaḥ śyenāso na aśvā ivārthaṃ gaṃtavyaṃ caraṃti | gacchaṃti | kīdṛśāḥ | mārutaṃ*
> *śardho na marutsaṃbaṃdhī gaṇa iva tuviṣṭaṇasastuvisvanā adhikadhvanayo bhavaṃti ||*

Summary

O Agni, those well-known rays of yours, overcoming enemies, swift-going, bright, fit to be attended, move to their goal like falcons (श्येनासो न (*śyenāso na*)). They are loud-sounding, with great noise, like the host of the Maruts.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ये ह (*ye ha*)—which of yours
- त्ये (*tye*)—well-known
- सहमानाः (*sahamānāḥ*)—not defeated by enemies
- आयासः (*āyāsaḥ*)—of moving nature
- त्वेषासः (*tveṣāsaḥ*)—shining (the text breaks off here)
- दुवसनासः (*duvasanāsaḥ*)—having the act of service
- ते (*te*)—those
- अर्चयः (*arcayaḥ*)—rays
- श्येनासः न (*śyenāsaḥ na*)—like horses
- मारुतं शर्धः न (*mārutaṃ śardhaḥ na*)—like the company of the Maruts
- तुविष्वणसः (*tuviṣvaṇasaḥ*)—sounding loudly
- अर्थं (*arthaṃ*)—the region to be reached
- चरंति (*caraṃti*)—go and reach

Gist

O Agni, those rays of yours, renowned, not overcome by enemies, of moving nature, radiant and having the act of service, go and reach their destined region, like horses and, like the company of the Maruts, sounding loudly.

English translation

Those, your rays, Agni, triumphant, wide-spreading, radiant, adorable, go like hawk-faced horses (to their goal), loud-sounding like the company of the Maruts.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अका॑रि॒ ब्रह्म॑ समिधान॒ तुभ्यं॒ शंसा॑त्यु॒क्थं यज॑ते॒ व्यूं॑ धाः ।
होता॑रम॒ग्निं मनुं॑षो॒ नि षे॑दुर्न॒मस्यन्त॑ उ॒शिज॒ः शंस॑मा॒योः ॥ ११ ॥

> *akāri brahma samidhāna tubhyaṃ śaṃsātyukthaṃ yajate vyū dhāḥ |*
> *hotāramagniṃ manuṣo ni ṣedurnamasyanta uśijaḥ śaṃsamāyoḥ ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अकारि । ब्रह्म । संइधान । तुभ्यं । शंसाति । उक्कं । यजते । वि । ऊं इति । धाः ।
> होतारं । अग्निं । मनुषः । नि । सेदुः । नमस्यंतः । उशिजः । शंसं । आयोः ॥११॥

> *akāri | brahma | saṃidhāna | tubhyaṃ | śaṃsāti | ukkaṃ | yajate | vi | ūṃ iti | dhāḥ |*
> *hotāraṃ | agniṃ | manuṣaḥ | ni | seduḥ | namasyaṃtaḥ | uśijaḥ | śaṃsaṃ | āyoḥ ‖11‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे समिधान समिध्यमानाग्ने तुभ्यं त्वदर्थं ब्रह्म स्तोत्रमकारि । अस्माभिः
> कृतं । होतोक्कं शस्त्ररूपं स्तोत्रं शंसाति । शंसति ॥ शन्नु स्तुता । लेटोऽडाटावित्याडागमः ॥
> त्वां यजमानो यजते । अतः कारणादस्मभ्यं धनं वि धाः ।
> विधेहि ॥ दधातेश्चांदसे लुजु बहुलं छंदसीत्यडभावः । उ इति पादपूरणः ! किंच

> *he samidhāna samidhyamānāgne tubhyaṃ tvadarthaṃ brahma*
> *stotramakāri | asmābhiḥ*
> *kṛtaṃ | hotokkaṃ śastrarūpaṃ stotraṃ śaṃsāti | śaṃsati ‖ śannu stutā*
> *| leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityāḍāgamaḥ ‖ tvāṃ yajamāno yajate | ataḥ*
> *kāraṇādasmabhyaṃ dhanaṃ vi dhāḥ |*
> *vidhehi ‖ dadhāteścāṃdase luju bahulaṃ chaṃdasītyaḍabhāvaḥ | u iti*
> *pādapūraṇaḥ ! kiṃca*

> आयोर्मनुष्यस्य शंसं शंसनीयं होतारं देवानामाह्वातारमग्निं त्वां नमस्यंतः पूजयंत उशिजः
> पश्वादिलक्षणं धनं कामयमाना मनुषो मनुष्या
> ऋत्विजो नि षेदुः । उपाविशन् । सेवंत इत्यर्थः ॥

> *āyormanuṣyasya śaṃsaṃ śaṃsanīyaṃ hotāraṃ*
> *devānāmāhvātāramagniṃ tvāṃ namasyaṃtaḥ pūjayaṃta uśijaḥ*
> *paśvādilakṣaṇaṃ dhanaṃ kāmayamānā manuṣo manuṣyā*
> *ṛtvijo ni ṣeduḥ | upāviśan | sevaṃta ityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

?419

"O Agni, being kindled (समिधान (*samidhāna*)), for you, for your sake, a ब्रह्म (*brahma*), that is, a hymn of praise, has been made by us." The hotā recites (शंसाति (*śaṃsāti*) = शंसति (*śaṃsati*)) the uktha, a praise in the form of a śastra. The sacrificer worships you. "For this reason bestow (वि धाः (*vi dhāḥ*) = विधेहि (*vidhehi*)) wealth upon us." The particle उ (*u*) is a filler of the pāda. And further: ...

... men (मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)), that is, the priests, desiring (उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*)) wealth of the nature of cattle and the like, worshipping you, Agni, the invoker of the gods, who is to be praised (शंसं (*śaṃsaṃ*)) by man (आयोः (*āyoḥ*)), have sat down (नि षेदुः (*ni ṣeduḥ*)), that is, have approached and serve you.

Word-to-word meaning

- समिधान (*samidhāna*)—O kindled Agni
- तुभ्यं (*tubhyaṃ*)—with you in view
- ब्रह्म (*brahma*)—the praise
- अकारि (*akāri*)—has been made
- उकथं (*ukathaṃ*)—the śastra-mantra
- शंसति (*śaṃsati*)—(the hotā) recites
- यजते (*yajate*)—(the sacrificer) worships, (therefore)
- वि धाः (*vi dhāḥ*)—provide wealth
- आयोः (*āyoḥ*)—to man
- शंसं (*śaṃsaṃ*)—the venerable one
- होतारं (*hotāraṃ*)—the one who calls the gods
- अग्निं (*agniṃ*)—you, Agni, the venerable
- नमस्यंतः (*namasyaṃtaḥ*)—worshipping
- उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*)—desiring wealth such as cattle
- मनुषः (*manuṣaḥ*)—the priests
- नि षेदुः (*ni ṣeduḥ*)—are serving (you)

Gist

O kindled Agni, a praise with you in view has been made; the hotā is reciting the praise in the form of a śastra. Therefore provide wealth. The priests, desiring wealth such as cattle, worshipping you, who are venerable to man, who call the gods to the sacrifice, and are venerable, are serving you.

English translation

Well-kindled Agni, for you the prayer has been composed : may (the priest) propitiate (you) by (his) praise : the (sacrificer) offers worship : bestow upon us manifold (wealth) : desiring (riches), men sit down adoring Agni, the invoker of the gods, the glorifier of mankind.

Sūkta 7 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अयमिहेत्येकादशर्चं सप्तमं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षमाग्नेयं । आद्या
> जगती द्वितीयाद्याः पंचानुष्टुभः शिष्टास्त्रिष्टुभः । तथा चानुक्रांतं । अयमिहादौ
> जगती पंचानुष्टुभ इति ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥ अग्निप्रणयनेऽयमिहेति
> वैश्यस्य प्रतिपत् । तथा च सूत्रितं । अयमिह प्रथमो धायि धातृभिरिति तु
> राजन्यवैश्ययोराद्ये । आ. २-१७ । इति ॥

> *ayamihetyekādaśarcaṃ saptamaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣamāgneyaṃ | ādyā*
> *jagatī dvitīyādyāḥ paṃcānuṣṭubhaḥ śiṣṭāstriṣṭubhaḥ | tathā cānukrāṃtaṃ | ayamihādau*
> *jagatī paṃcānuṣṭubha iti ‖ sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ‖ agnipraṇayane 'yamiheti*
> *vaiśyasya pratipat | tathā ca sūtritaṃ | ayamiha prathamo dhāyi dhātṛbhiriti tu*
> *rājanyavaiśyayorādye | ā. 2-17 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The seventh sūkta, beginning अयमिह (*ayamiha*), of eleven ṛks, has Vāmadeva as seer and Agni as deity. The first verse is a jagatī, the next five are anuṣṭubhs, the rest triṣṭubhs. So the Anukramaṇī says: अयमिहादौ जगती पंचानुष्टुभ इति (*ayamihādau jagatī paṃcānuṣṭubha iti*). The use of the sūkta is by the Liṅga (indicative sign). In the Agnipraṇayana (the leading forth of the fire), अयमिह (*ayamiha*) is the pratipad of the Vaiśya. As the sūtra states: अयमिह प्रथमो धायि धातृभिरिति तु राजन्यवैश्ययोराद्ये (*ayamiha prathamo dhāyi dhātṛbhiriti tu rājanyavaiśyayorādye*) (Ā. Sū. 2-17).

Anuvāda: This sūkta beginning आयमिह (*āyamiha*) is the seventh sūkta in the first anuvāka. It has eleven ṛks. Vāmadeva is the seer of this sūkta; Agni is the deity. The first ṛk of this sūkta is in the jagatī metre. From the second ṛk to the sixth the metre is anuṣṭubh; the remaining ṛks are in the triṣṭubh metre. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said: अयमिहादौ जगती पंचानुष्टभः (*ayamihādau jagatī paṃcānuṣṭabhaḥ*). The use of the sūkta is by the Liṅga. In the rite called Agnipraṇayana (the rite of carrying the fire, churned and produced at the sacrifice, from the place of its production to the northern altar, is called Agnipraṇayana), this ṛk beginning अयमिह (*ayamiha*) is to be recited by a Vaiśya sacrificer as the ṛk called pratipad; this is set out in the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra by the sūtra अयमिह प्रथमो धायि धातृभिरिति तु राजन्यवैश्ययोराद्ये (*ayamiha prathamo dhāyi dhātṛbhiriti tu rājanyavaiśyayorādye*) (Ā. Sū. 2-17).

Sūkta 2?420

- Maṇḍala 4; Anuvāka 1; Sūkta 2
- Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 5; Varga 6, 7
- Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 11
- Seer: Vāmadeva
- Deity: Agni
- Metre: 1 jagatī; 2–6 anuṣṭubh; 7–11 jagatī

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यमि॒ह प्र॑थ॒मो धा॑यि धा॒तृभि॒र्हो॑ता॒ यजि॑ष्ठो अध्व॒रे
ष्वीड्य॑ः ।
यमप्न॑वानो॒ भृग॑वो विरु॒रुचुर्वने॑षु चि॒त्रं वि॒भ्वं॑ वि॒शेवि॑
शे ॥ १ ॥

> *ayamiha prathamo dhāyi dhātṛbhirhotā yajiṣṭho adhvareṣvīḍyaḥ |*
> *yamapnavāno bhṛgavo virurucurvaneṣu citraṃ vibhvaṃ viśeviśe ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । इह । प्रथमः। धायि । धातृभिः । होता । यजिष्ठः । अध्वरेषु । ईड्यः ।
> यं । अप्पवानः । भृगवः । विरुरुचुः । वनेषु । चित्रं । विभ्वं । विशेऽविशे ॥ १ ॥

> *ayaṃ | iha | prathamaḥ| dhāyi | dhātṛbhiḥ | hotā | yajiṣṭhaḥ | adhvareṣu | īḍyaḥ |*
> *yaṃ | appavānaḥ | bhṛgavaḥ | virurucuḥ | vaneṣu | citraṃ | vibhvaṃ | viśe 'viśe ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> धातृभिर्यज्ञार्थं कर्म कुर्वद्धिरध्वर्युभिरिहास्यज्ञे होता देवानामाह्वाता यजिष्ठोऽतिशयेन यष्टाध्वरेषु यागेष्विद्य ऋत्विग्निः स्तूयमानः
> प्रथमः सर्वेषां देवानां मुख्योऽयवाहवनीयादिस्थानेषु प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानोऽग्निर्धायि । अधायि । निहितः ॥ दधातेः कर्मणि लुज् । बहुलं छंदस्यमाजत्योग इत्यडभावः । तिङ्ङतिज इति निघातः ॥ अयमग्निरित्युक्तं । कोऽसावग्निरित्यत आह । अप्पवानो भृगुसंबंधी कश्चिदृषिः स चान्वे भृगवश्च वनेष्वरण्येषु
> चित्रं दावाग्निरूपेण बहुधा दर्शनीयं विशे विशे । वीप्सया सर्वजनव्याप्तिर्गृह्यते । सर्वस्या विशः प्रजाया विभ्वं विभुमीश्वरं यं देवानां हविर्वाहकत्वेन
> प्रसिद्धमग्निं विरुरुचुः । दीप्तियुक्तं कुर्वंति स्म । यमिति यच्छब्दस्यायमितीदंशब्बेन संबंधः ॥

> *dhātṛbhiryajñārthaṃ karma kurvaddhiradhvaryubhirihāsyajñe hotā devānāmāhvātā yajiṣṭho 'tiśayena yaṣṭādhvareṣu yāgeṣvidya ṛtvigniḥ stūyamānaḥ*
> *prathamaḥ sarvèṣāṃ devānāṃ mukhyo 'yavāhavanīyādisthāneṣu pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamāno 'gnirdhāyi | adhāyi | nihitaḥ ‖ dadhāteḥ karmaṇi luj | bahulaṃ chaṃdasyamājatyoga ityaḍabhāvaḥ | tiṅṅatija iti nighātaḥ ‖ ayamagnirityuktaṃ | ko 'sāvagnirityata āha | appavāno bhṛgusaṃbaṃdhī kaścidṛṣiḥ sa cānve bhṛgavaśca vaneṣvaraṇyeṣu*
> *citraṃ dāvāgnirūpeṇa bahudhā darśanīyaṃ viśe viśe | vīpsayā sarvajanavyāptirgṛhyate | sarvasyā viśaḥ prajāyā vibhvaṃ vibhumīśvaraṃ yaṃ devānāṃ havirvāhakatvena*
> *prasiddhamagniṃ virurucuḥ | dīptiyuktaṃ kurvaṃti sma | yamiti yacchabdasyāyamitīdaṃśabbena saṃbaṃdhaḥ ‖*

Summary

Here, in this sacrifice, by the dhātṛs (धातृभिः (*dhātṛbhiḥ*)), the adhvaryus who perform the rite for the sacrifice, this Agni has been placed (धायि (*dhāyi*) = अधायि (*adhāyi*), set down): the hotā, the invoker of the gods; यजिष्ठः (*yajiṣṭhaḥ*), the most excellent sacrificer; the one to be praised at the adhvaras, the sacrifices; प्रथमः (*prathamaḥ*), first, chief of all the gods; perceived directly in the places of the Āhavanīya and so on.[?421] "This Agni" has been said; who is this Agni? He replies: whom Apnavāna, a certain seer connected with Bhṛgu, and the other Bhṛgus, made to shine (विरुरुचुः (*virurucuḥ*), made radiant) in the woods, in the forests; चित्रं (*citraṃ*), wondrous, to be seen in many ways in the form of the forest-fire. विशे विशे (*viśe viśe*): by the repetition the pervasion of all people is understood: for every people. विभ्वं (*vibhvaṃ*), the lord, the master, famed as the bearer of oblations of the gods. The relative यं (*yaṃ*) is connected with the demonstrative अयं (*ayaṃ*) ("this").

Word-to-word meaning

- अप्नवानः (*apnavānaḥ*)—the seer named Apnavāna
- भृगवः (*bhṛgavaḥ*)—and the other seers born in the line of Bhṛgu
- वनेषु (*vaneṣu*)—in the forests
- चित्रं (*citraṃ*)—who is worth seeing in the form of forest-fire
- विशे विशे (*viśe viśe*)—for all peoples
- विभ्वं (*vibhvaṃ*)—and lord
- यं (*yaṃ*)—which Agni
- विरुरुचुः (*virurucuḥ*)—they made blazing, such
- होता (*hotā*)—who is in the form of the hotā
- यजिष्ठः (*yajiṣṭhaḥ*)—the most venerable
- अध्वरेषु (*adhvareṣu*)—in the sacrifices
- ईड्यः (*īḍyaḥ*)—who is praised
- प्रथमः (*prathamaḥ*)—the first of all gods
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this Agni
- धातृभिः (*dhātṛbhiḥ*)—by the adhvaryus who perform the sacrifice
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrifice
- धायि (*dhāyi*)—has been established

Gist

This Agni, in the form of the hotā, the most venerable, praised in the sacrifices, first of all gods, whom the seer Apnavāna and the other seers born in the line of Bhṛgu made blaze in the forests, he who is worth seeing in the form of forest-fire and lord of all peoples, has been established in this sacrifice by the adhvaryus who perform the sacrifice.

English translation

This invoker of the gods and minister of frequent worship, who is to be glorified at sacrifices, has been placed first (of the gods) by the performers of the rite : Agni whom Apnavana and other Bhrigus lighted in the woods for the sake of all men, marvellous (in his acts), and sovereign (over all).

Special Topics

अप्नवानः (*apnavānaḥ*)—The commentator says that Apnavāna is a certain seer born in the line of Bhṛgu. The name of this seer occurs in the Ṛgveda in the present ṛk and also in the ṛk जीवभृगुवच्छुचिमप्नवानवदा हुवे । अग्निं समुद्रवाससं॥ (*jīvabhṛguvacchucimapnavānavadā huve | agniṃ samudravāsasaṃ‖*) (Mu. Saṃ. 8-102-4).[?422] The same mantra is also stated in the Taittirīya Saṃhitā. "I shall invoke as Apnavāna, the seer born in the line of Bhṛgu, invoked Agni": thus the seer Prayoga of the same line speaks here. Although this seer is renowned, there is no occasion to learn more details about him.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अग्ने॑ क॒दा त॑ आनु॒षग्भुव॑द्दे॒वस्य॒ चेत॑नम् ।
अधा॒ हि त्वा॑ जगृभ्रि॒रे मर्ता॑सो वि॒क्ष्वीड्य॑म् ॥ २ ॥

> *agne kadā ta ānuṣagbhuvaddevasya cetanam |*
> *adhā hi tvā jagṛbhrire martāso vikṣvīḍyam ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अग्ने । कदा । ते । अनुषक् । भुवत् । देवस्य । चेतनं ।
> अध । हि । त्वा । जगृभ्रिरे । मर्तासः । विक्षु । ईड्यं ॥ २ ॥

> *agne | kadā | te | anuṣak | bhuvat | devasya | cetanaṃ |*
> *adha | hi | tvā | jagṛbhrire | martāsaḥ | vikṣu | īḍyaṃ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्ने कदा त इति। प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोराग्नेये क्रतावानुष्टुभे छंदस्याग्ने कदा त इत्याद्याः पंचर्चः । सूत्रितं च । अग्ने कदा त इति पंच । आ. ४. १३ ।
> इति ॥

> *agne kadā ta iti| prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayorāgneye kratāvānuṣṭubhe chaṃdasyāgne kadā ta ityādyāḥ paṃcarcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | agne kadā ta iti paṃca | ā. 4. 13 |*
> *iti ‖*

> हे अग्ने अधातः कारणाद्देवस्य द्योतमानस्य ते तव संबंधि चेतनं तेजः
> कदानुषक् अनुषक्तं भुवत् । भवेत् ॥ लेट्यडागमः । बहुलं छंदसीति विकरणस्य
> लुक् । भूसुवोस्तिजीति गुणप्रतिषेधः ॥ अतः कारणादित्युक्तं । कस्माद्धेतोरित्युच्यते । हि
> यस्मात्कारणान्मर्तासो मनुष्या विक्षु विड्भिः प्रजाभिरीड्यं स्तुत्यं त्वा त्वां
> जगृभ्रिरे । जगृहिरे । गृह्णंति ॥ ग्रहेर्धातोर्लिटि हृग्रहोर्भ इति भत्वं । बहुलं
> छंदसीति रुडागमः ॥

> *he agne adhātaḥ kāraṇāddevasya dyotamānasya te tava saṃbaṃdhi cetanaṃ tejaḥ*
> *kadānuṣak anuṣaktaṃ bhuvat | bhavet ‖ leṭyaḍāgamaḥ | bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya*
> *luk | bhūsuvostijīti guṇapratiṣedhaḥ ‖ ataḥ kāraṇādityuktaṃ | kasmāddhetorityucyate | hi yasmātkāraṇānmartāso manuṣyā vikṣu viḍbhiḥ prajābhirīḍyaṃ stutyaṃ tvā tvāṃ*
> *jagṛbhrire | jagṛhire | gṛhṇaṃti ‖ graherdhātorliṭi hṛgrahorbha iti bhatvaṃ | bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti ruḍāgamaḥ ‖*

Summary

Use: in the prātaranuvāka and in the Āśvina śastra, in the Āgneya kratu, in the anuṣṭubh metre, the five ṛks beginning अग्ने कदा त (*agne kadā ta*) are used. And it is stated in the sūtra: अग्ने कदा त इति पंच (*agne kadā ta iti paṃca*) (Ā. Sū. 4. 13).

O Agni, when will the light (चेतनं (*cetanaṃ*), brightness) of you, shining (देवस्य (*devasya*)), be continuous (आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*), attached; भुवत् (*bhuvat*) = भवेत् (*bhavet*))? अध (*adha*) = "for this reason"; for what reason is next said: because (हि (*hi*)) mortals (मर्तासः (*martāsaḥ*)), men, among the peoples (विक्षु (*vikṣu*)) have taken you (जगृभ्रिरे (*jagṛbhrire*) = जगृहिरे (*jagṛhire*)), worthy of praise.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- हि (*hi*)—by whose greatness of yours
- मर्तासः (*martāsaḥ*)—men
- विक्षु (*vikṣu*)—among the peoples
- ईड्यं (*īḍyaṃ*)—worthy of praise
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- जगृभिरे (*jagṛbhire*)—have taken up?423
- अध (*adha*)—for that reason
- देवस्य (*devasya*)—of the shining
- ते (*te*)—of you
- चेतनं (*cetanaṃ*)—the brightness
- कदा (*kadā*)—when
- आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)—manifest?424
- भुवत् (*bhuvat*)—becomes

Gist

O Agni, by whose greatness men have borne you, praised among the peoples, for that reason, when does your brightness, shining, become manifest?

English translation

When, Agni, is the light of you, bright-shining, to be manifested? for therefore have mortals accepted you as to be worshipped amongst mankind.

Special Topics

In the recitation of the prātaranuvāka and of the Āśvina śastra mantras, the five ṛks of this sūkta beginning अग्ने कदा ते (*agne kadā te*), in the anuṣṭubh metre, are used for the ṛks related to the Āgneya kratu; this is set out in the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra by the sūtra अग्ने कदा त इति पंच (*agne kadā ta iti paṃca*) (Ā. Sū. 4-13).

Ṛk 3

Samhitā-pāṭha

ऋ॒तावा॑नं॒ विचे॑तसं॒ पश्यं॑न्तो॒ द्यामिं॑व॒ स्तृभिं॑ः ।
विश्वे॑षामध्व॒राणां᳚ हस्क॒र्तारं॒ दमे॑दमे ॥ ३ ॥

> *ṛtāvānaṃ vicetasaṃ paśyanto dyāmiva stṛbhiḥ |*
> *viśveṣāmadhvarāṇāṃ haskartāraṃ damedame ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऋतसानं । विचेतसं । पश्यंतः । द्यांइव । स्तुभिः ।
> विश्वेषां । अध्वराणां । हस्कर्तारं । दमेदमे ॥ ३ ॥

> *ṛtasānaṃ | vicetasaṃ | paśyaṃtaḥ | dyāṃiva | stubhiḥ |*
> *viśveṣāṃ | adhvarāṇāṃ | haskartāraṃ | damedame ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ऋतानानममायिनं विचेतसं विशिष्टज्ञानं स्तृभिर्नक्षत्रैः परिवृतं द्यामिव।
> विस्फुलिंगैः समेतं विश्वेषां सर्वेषामध्वराणां यज्ञानां हस्कर्तारं प्रभासकं
> वृद्धेः कर्तारं वाग्निं पश्यंत ऋत्विगादयो दमे दमे सर्वस्मिन्यज्ञगृहे जगृभिर
> इति पूर्वेण संबंधः ॥

> *ṛtānānamamāyinaṃ vicetasaṃ viśiṣṭajñānaṃ stṛbhirnakṣatraiḥ*
> *parivṛtaṃ dyāmiva* |
> *visphuliṃgaiḥ sametaṃ viśveṣāṃ sarvèṣāmadhvarāṇāṃ yajñānāṃ*
> *haskartāraṃ prabhāsakaṃ*
> *vṛddheḥ kartāraṃ vāgniṃ paśyaṃta ṛtvigādayo dame dame*
> *sarvasminyajñagṛhe jagṛbhira*
> *iti pūrveṇa saṃbaṃdhaḥ* ‖

Summary

The truthful one (ऋतावानं (*ṛtāvānaṃ*)), free from deceit, of distinguished knowledge, is encircled by stars (स्तृभिः (*stṛbhiḥ*)) as the sky is, that is, he is accompanied by sparks.[?425] The priests and others behold this Agni, the "perfecter" of all sacrifices (हस्कर्तारं (*haskartāraṃ*)), that is, the illuminator, the one who brings about increase. In every sacrificial house (दमे दमे (*dame dame*)) they "have borne" him (जगृभिर (*jagṛbhira*)). This is connected with the preceding verse.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋतावानं (*ṛtāvānaṃ*)—the truthful one
- विचेतसं (*vicetasaṃ*)—the one of distinguished intelligence
- स्तृभिः (*stṛbhiḥ*)—with stars
- द्यामिव (*dyāmiva*)—like the sky
- विश्वेषां (*viśveṣāṃ*)—of all
- आध्वराणां (*ādhvarāṇāṃ*)—of the sacrifices
- हस्कर्तारं (*haskartāraṃ*)—the one who brings about illumination, that is, Agni
- पश्यंतः (*paśyaṃtaḥ*)—beholding
- दमे दमे (*dame dame*)—in every sacrificial house (the priests and others bear him)

Gist

Beholding Agni, who is truthful, of distinguished intelligence, and who brings illumination to all sacrifices as the sky is adorned with stars, the priests and others bear him in every sacrificial house.

English translation

Contemplating you in every dwelling, truthful, intelligent, (brilliant with sparks) like the sky with stars, the perfecter of all sacrifices.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒शुं दू॒तं वि॒वस्व॑तो॒ विश्वा॒ यश्च॑र्ष॒णीर॒भि ।
आ ज॑भ्रुः के॒तुमा॒यवो॒ भृग॑वाणं वि॒शेवि॑शे ॥ ४ ॥

> *āśuṃ dūtaṃ vivasvato viśvā yaścarṣaṇīrabhi |*
> *ā jabhruḥ ketumāyavo bhṛgavāṇaṃ viśeviśe ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आशुं । दूतं । विवस्वतः । विश्वाः । यः । चर्षणीः । अभि ।
> आ । जभ्रुः । केतुं । आयवः । भृगवाणं । विशेऽविशे ॥ ४ ॥

> *āśuṃ | dūtaṃ | vivasvataḥ | viśvāḥ | yaḥ | carṣaṇīḥ | abhi |*
> *ā | jabhruḥ | ketuṃ | āyavaḥ | bhṛgavāṇaṃ | viśe 'viśe ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> योग्निर्विश्वाश्चर्षणीः सर्वाः प्रजा अभि भवति आयवो मनुष्याः । आयव
> इति मनुष्यनाम आयवो यदव इति मनुष्यनामसु नाठात् । आशुं क्षिप्रगामिनं
> विवस्वतो मनुष्यस्य यजमानस्य दूतं । विवस्वत इति मनुष्यनामेदं । केतुं
> प्रज्ञापकं भृगवाणं भृगुवदाचरंतं । दीप्यमानमित्यर्थः ॥ सर्वप्रातिपदिकेभ्यः
> क्विब्वक्तव्य इति क्विप् । तदंताल्लटो व्यत्ययेन शानच् । अदुपदेशाल्लसार्वधातुकानुदात्तत्वे
> प्राप्ते वृषादेराकृतिगणत्वादाद्युदात्तत्वं ॥ तमग्निं विशे विशे
> सर्वस्यै प्रजाया आ जभ्रुः । आजह्रुः ॥ हृग्रहोर्भ इति भत्वं ॥

> *yognirviśvāścarṣaṇīḥ sarvāḥ prajā abhi bhavati āyavo manuṣyāḥ | āyava*
> *iti manuṣyanāma āyavo yadava iti manuṣyanāmasu nāṭhāt | āśuṃ kṣipragāminaṃ*
> *vivasvato manuṣyasya yajamānasya dūtaṃ | vivasvata iti manuṣyanāmedaṃ | ketuṃ*
> *prajñāpakaṃ bhṛgavāṇaṃ bhṛguvadācaraṃtaṃ | dīpyamānamityarthaḥ ‖ sarvaprātipadikebhyaḥ*

> *kvibvaktavya iti kvip | tadaṃtāllaṭo vyatyayena śānac | adupadeśāllasārvadhātukānudāttatve prāpte vṛṣāderākṛtigaṇatvādādyudāttatvaṃ ‖ tamagniṃ viśe viśe sarvasyè prajāyā ā jabhruḥ | ājahruḥ ‖ hṛgrahorbha iti bhatvaṃ ‖*

Summary

The Agni who prevails over all peoples (विश्वाश्चर्षणीः (*viśvāścarṣaṇīḥ*)), all subjects—the आयवः (*āyavaḥ*) are men; आयवो यदव इति मनुष्यनामसु नाठात् (*āyavo yadava iti manuṣyanāmasu nāṭhāt*) (read among the names of men)—that Agni, the swift-going (आशुं (*āśuṃ*)), is the messenger (दूतं (*dūtaṃ*)) of Vivasvat, that is, of man, the sacrificer; विवस्वत इति मनुष्यनामेदं (*vivasvata iti manuṣyanāmedaṃ*). He is the "banner" (केतुं (*ketuṃ*)), the one who makes things known, and भृगवाणं (*bhṛgavāṇaṃ*), one who behaves like Bhṛgu, that is, shining. That Agni, for every people (विशे विशे (*viśe viśe*)), they have brought (आ जभ्रुः (*ā jabhruḥ*) = आजह्रुः (*ājahruḥ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—that very Agni who
- विश्वाः (*viśvāḥ*)—all
- चर्षणीः (*carṣaṇīḥ*)—peoples
- अभि (*abhi*)—is lord over (such a one)
- आशुं (*āśuṃ*)—the swift-going one
- विवस्वतः (*vivasvataḥ*)—of the sacrificer
- दूतं (*dūtaṃ*)—the messenger (who calls the gods)
- केतुं (*ketuṃ*)—the giver of knowledge
- भृगवाणं (*bhṛgavāṇaṃ*)—the resplendent one; that Agni
- विशेविशे (*viśeviśe*)—in every sacrificial house
- आयवः (*āyavaḥ*)—men, the sacrificers
- आ जभ्रुः (*ā jabhruḥ*)—have brought

Gist

Agni is the lord of all peoples. That Agni, who is swift-going, the messenger who calls the gods for the sacrificer, the giver of knowledge, the resplendent one, men the sacrificers have brought to every sacrificial house.

English translation

Men have brought, for the sake of all people, the swift messenger of the worshipper (to the gods), who (rules) over all mankind, the manifester, the resplendent.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तमी॒ं होता॑रमानु॒षक्चिं॑कि॒त्वांसं॒ नि षें॑दिरे ।
र॒ण्वं पा॑व॒कशो॑चिषं॒ यजिं॑ष्ठं स॒प्त धाम॑भिः ॥ ५ ॥

> *tamīṃ hotāramānuṣakcikitvāṃsaṃ ni ṣedire |*
> *raṇvaṃ pāvakaśociṣaṃ yajiṣṭhaṃ sapta dhāmabhiḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । ईं । होतारं । आनुषक् । चिकित्वांसं । नि। सेदिरे ।
> रण्वं । पावकशोचिषं । यजिष्ठं । सप्त । धामभिः ॥ ५ ॥

> *taṃ | īṃ | hotāraṃ | ānuṣak | cikitvāṃsaṃ | ni| sedire |*
> *raṇvaṃ | pāvakaśociṣaṃ | yajiṣṭhaṃ | sapta | dhāmabhiḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ऋत्विगादयो मनुष्या आनुषक् आनुपूर्व्येण होतारं देवानामाह्वातारं चिकित्वांसं जानंतं ॥ कित ज्ञाने । लिटः क्वसुः । द्विर्भावहलादिशेषचुत्वदीर्घाः । प्रत्ययस्वरः ॥ तमीं तमिममग्निं नि षेदिरे । निषादयंति स्म । कीदृशं ।
> रण्वं रमणीयं पावकशोचिषं शोधकदीप्तिं यजिष्टं यष्टृतमं सप्त सप्तभिर्धामभिस्तेजोभिर्युक्तं ॥

> *ṛtvigādayo manuṣyā ānuṣak ānupūrvyeṇa hotāraṃ devānāmāhvātāraṃ cikitvāṃsaṃ jānaṃtaṃ ‖ kita jñāne | liṭaḥ kvasuḥ | dvirbhāvahalādiśeṣacutvadīrghāḥ | pratyayasvaraḥ ‖ tamīṃ tamimamagniṃ ni ṣedire | niṣādayaṃti sma | kīdṛśaṃ |*
> *raṇvaṃ ramaṇīyaṃ pāvakaśociṣaṃ śodhakadīptiṃ yajiṣṭaṃ yaṣṭṛtamaṃ sapta saptabhirdhāmabhistejobhiryuktaṃ ‖*

Summary

The priests and others, men, have seated (नि षेदिरे (*ni ṣedire*), निषादयंति स्म (*niṣādayaṃti sma*)) that very Agni in due order (आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*), आनुपूर्व्येण (*ānupūrvyeṇa*)). He is the invoker (होतारं (*hotāraṃ*)) of the gods, the one who knows (चिकित्वांसं (*cikitvāṃsaṃ*), from the root कित ज्ञाने (*kita jñāne*)). Of what kind? Delightful (रण्वं (*raṇvaṃ*)), of purifying radiance (पावकशोचिषं (*pāvakaśociṣaṃ*)), the best sacrificer (यजिष्टं (*yajiṣṭaṃ*), यष्टृतमं (*yaṣṭṛtamaṃ*)), endowed with seven (सप्त (*sapta*)) abodes, that is, with seven lustres (धामभिः (*dhāmabhiḥ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- होतारं (*hotāraṃ*)—the one who invokes the gods (to the sacrifice)
- चिकित्वांसं (*cikitvāṃsaṃ*)—the wise one
- रण्वं (*raṇvaṃ*)—the one of delightful form
- पावकशोचिसं (*pāvakaśocisaṃ*)—the one of purifying radiance
- यजिष्ठं (*yajiṣṭhaṃ*)—the most worshipful (the frequent sacrificer)
- सप्त धामभिः (*sapta dhāmabhiḥ*)—endowed with seven lustres
- तमीं (*tamīṃ*)—that same Agni
- आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)—following the order of his place
- नि षेदिरे (*ni ṣedire*)—(the priests) establish

Gist

That same Agni, who invokes the gods to the sacrifice, who is wise, of delightful form, of purifying radiance, most worshipful, endowed with seven lustres, the priests establish following the order of his place.

English translation

They (the worshippers) have seated him in his due order, the invoker (of the gods) the intelligent, the agreeable, the purifyingly-radiant, the per- former of frequent sacrifice, (brilliant) with seven flames.

Special Topics

सप्त धामभिः (*sapta dhāmabhiḥ*)—Agni has seven flames known as Kālī, Karālī and so on. The meaning is: with such flames.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तं शश्व॑तीषु मा॒तृषु॒ वन॒ आ वी॒तमश्रि॑तम् ।
चि॒त्रं सन्तं॒ गुहा॑ हि॒तं सु॒वेदं॑ कूचिद॒र्थिन॑म् ॥ ६ ॥

> *taṃ śaśvatīṣu mātṛṣu vana ā vītamaśritam |*
> *citraṃ santaṃ guhā hitaṃ suvedaṃ kūcidarthinam ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । शश्वतीषु । मातृषु । वने । आ! वीतं। अश्रितं ।
> चित्रं । संतं । गुहा । हितं । सुवेदं । कूचित् अर्थिनं ॥ ६ ॥

> *taṃ | śaśvatīṣu | mātṛṣu | vane | ā! vītaṃ| aśritaṃ |*
> *citraṃ | saṃtaṃ | guhā | hitaṃ | suvedaṃ | kūcit arthinaṃ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> शश्वतीषु बह्वीषु मातृष्टप्पु । तार्क सस्यादिनिर्मातृकत्वान्मातर इत्युच्यंते ।
> वन आ वृक्षसमूहे च । आकारश्चार्थे । संतं विद्यमानं वीतं कांतमश्रितं
> प्राणिभिर्वाहभयादसेवितं । दुरासदमित्यर्थः । चित्रं चायनीयं गुहा गुहायां
> हितं निहितं सुवेदं सुविज्ञानं सुधनं वा कूचिदर्थिनं क्वापि हविष्यर्थिनं समिदाज्यपुरोडाशादि
> हविः स्वीकुर्वंतं ॥ क्वेत्यत्र वकारस्य छंदसे संप्रसारणे परपूर्वत्वे च हल इति दीर्घत्वं ॥
> एवंभूतमग्निं निषेदिग इति पूर्वेण संबंधः ॥

> *śaśvatīṣu bahvīṣu mātṛṣṭappu | tārka sasyādinirmātṛkatvānmātara ityucyaṃte |*
> *vana ā vṛkṣasamūhe ca | ākāraścārthe | saṃtaṃ vidyamānaṃ vītaṃ kāṃtamaśritaṃ prāṇibhirvāhabhayādasevitaṃ | durāsadamityarthaḥ | citraṃ cāyanīyaṃ guhā guhāyāṃ*
> *hitaṃ nihitaṃ suvedaṃ suvijñānaṃ sudhanaṃ vā kūcidarthinaṃ kvāpi haviṣyarthinaṃ samidājyapuroḍāśādi haviḥ svīkurvaṃtaṃ ‖ kvetyatra vakārasya chaṃdase saṃprasāraṇe parapūrvatve ca hala iti dīrghatvaṃ ‖ evaṃbhūtamagniṃ niṣediga iti pūrveṇa saṃbaṃdhaḥ ‖*

Summary

शश्वतीषु (*śaśvatīṣu*) means many; in the many mothers (मातृषु (*mātṛṣu*)), the waters—they are called mothers because they produce plants and the like. And in the forest (वने (*vane*)), in the groups of trees; the आ (*ā*) has the sense of "and". Agni is existing (संतं (*saṃtaṃ*)), desirable (वीतं (*vītaṃ*)), not resorted to (अश्रितं (*aśritaṃ*)) by creatures through fear of burning, that is, hard to approach.[?426] He is wonderful (चित्रं (*citraṃ*), चायनीयं (*cāyanīyaṃ*)), placed in a cave (गुहा हितं (*guhā hitaṃ*)), easily known (सुवेदं (*suvedaṃ*)) or of good wealth, desiring (अर्थिनं (*arthinaṃ*)) an oblation anywhere (कूचित् (*kūcit*)), accepting oblations such as kindling-sticks, ghee and cake. Such an Agni "they have seated"—this is connected with the preceding verse.

Word-to-word meaning

- शश्वतीषु (*śaśvatīṣu*)—of many kinds
- मातृषु (*mātṛṣu*)—in the waters that have the form of mothers
- वने आ (*vane ā*)—and in groups of trees
- संतं (*saṃtaṃ*)—the one who is hidden
- वीतं (*vītaṃ*)—the attractive one
- अश्रितं (*aśritaṃ*)—one served (by all) (or one who cannot be approached)
- चित्रं (*citraṃ*)—the one of charming form
- गुहा (*guhā*)—in a cave
- हितं (*hitaṃ*)—placed
- सुवेदं (*suvedaṃ*)—the one of excellent wealth
- कूचिदर्थिनं (*kūcidarthinaṃ*)—the one who accepts oblations, that is, Agni (the priests and others have established)

Gist

Agni, who is hidden in the waters that stand in the place of mothers and in trees, who is attractive, served by all, of charming form, placed in a cave, of excellent wealth, who accepts oblations, the priests and others have established.

English translation

Him, abiding in the maternal (water) and in the woods, loved, yet unapproached, wonderful, hidden in a cave, endowed with knowledge, seeking (oblations) from any quarter.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒सस्य॒ यद्वियु॑ता॒ सस्मि॒न्नूध॑न्नृ॒तस्य॒ धाम॑न्र॒णय॑न्त दे॒वाः ।
म॒हाँ अ॒ग्निर्नम॑सा रा॒तह॑व्यो॒ वेर॑ध्व॒राय॒ सद॒मिदृ॒तावा॑ ॥ ७ ॥

> *sasasya yadviyutā sasminnūdhannṛtasya dhāmanraṇayanta devāḥ |*
> *mahā~ agnirnamasā rātahavyo veradhvarāya sadamidṛtāvā ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ससस्य । यत् । वियुता । सस्मिन् । ऊधन् । ऋतस्य । धामन् । रणयंत । देवाः ।
> महान् । अग्निः । नमसा । रातहव्यः । वेः । अध्वराय । सदं । इत् । ऋतवा ॥७॥

> *sasasya | yat | viyutā | sasmin | ūdhan | ṛtasya | dhāman | raṇayaṃta | devāḥ |*
> *mahān | agniḥ | namasā | rātahavyaḥ | veḥ | adhvarāya | sadaṃ | it | ṛtavā ‖7‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोस्त्रैष्टुभे छंदसि ससस्य यद्वियुतेत्याद्याः पंचर्चः । सूत्रितं च । ससस्य यद्वियुतेति पंच । आ. ४–१३ । इति ॥
> यद्यमग्निं देवाः स्तोतारः ससस्य स्वप्नस्य वियुता वियुते वियोगे ।
> उषसीत्यर्थः। ऋतस्योदकस्य धामन् धामनि स्थाने सस्मिन् सर्वस्मिन्नूधन्नूधनि यज्ञे
> रणयंत । रमयंति । स्तोत्रैरिति शेषः । महान्प्रभूतो नमसा नमस्कारेण
> रातहव्यो दत्तहविष्क ऋतावा सत्यवान् सोऽग्निः सदमित्सदैनाध्वरायाध्वरं यजमानैः कृतं यज्ञं ॥ सुपां सुपो भवंतीति व्यक्तव्यं । म. ७–१–३९ । इति वचनादत्र द्वितीयार्थे चतुर्थि ॥
> वेः । वेत्ति । जानाति । यद्वा । देवा इंद्रादयः

> *prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayostraiṣṭubhe chaṃdasi sasasya*
> *yadviyutetyādyāḥ paṃcarcaḥ | sūtritaṃ ca | sasasya yadviyuteti paṃca*
> *| ā. 4-13 | iti ||*
> *yadyamagniṃ devāḥ stotāraḥ sasasya svapnasya viyutā viyute viyoge |*
> *uṣasītyarthaḥ| ṛtasyodakasya dhāman dhāmani sthāne sasmin*
> *sarvasminnūdhannūdhani yajñe*
> *raṇayaṃta | ramayaṃti | stotrairiti śeṣaḥ | mahānprabhūto namasā*
> *namaskāreṇa*
> *rātahavyo dattahaviṣka ṛtāvā satyavān so 'gniḥ*
> *sadamitsadainādhvarāyādhvaraṃ yajamānaiḥ kṛtaṃ yajñaṃ || supāṃ*
> *supo bhavaṃtīti vyaktavyaṃ | ma. 7-1-39 | iti vacanādatra dvitīyārthe*
> *caturthi || veḥ | vetti | jānāti | yadvā | devā iṃdrādayaḥ*

> ससस्य ऋत्विग्भिः सेव्यस्य यद्यस्याग्निर्वियुता विशिष्टे सस्मिन् भजनीय ऋतस्य सत्यस्य
> धामन् धामनि योनावूधन्नूधनि यज्ञे रणयंत । रमयंते । महान्प्रभूतो नमसा हविषा रातहव्यो
> दत्तहविष्क ऋताना सत्यवान् सोऽग्निरध्वराय
> यज्ञार्थं सदमित्यदैव वेः । गंता भवति । अध्वराय यज्ञं वेः कामयते वा ॥

> *sasasya ṛtvigbhiḥ sevyasya yadyasyāgnirviyutā viśiṣṭe sasmin bhajanīya*
> *ṛtasya satyasya*
> *dhāman dhāmani yonāvūdhannūdhani yajñe raṇayaṃta | ramayaṃte |*
> *mahānprabhūto namasā haviṣā rātahavyo dattahaviṣka ṛtānā satyavān*
> *so 'gniradhvarāya*
> *yajñārthaṃ sadamityadaiva veḥ | gaṃtā bhavati | adhvarāya yajñaṃ*
> *veḥ kāmayate vā ||*

Summary

In the Prātaranuvāka and in the Āśvina-śastra, in the triṣṭubh metre, the five Ṛks beginning ससस्य यद्वियुता (*sasasya yadviyutā*) are used; and it is stated in the sūtra: ससस्य यद्वियुतेति पंच (*sasasya yadviyuteti paṃca*) (Ā. Sū. 4-13).

The Agni whom the gods, that is, the praisers, delight (रणयंत (*raṇayaṃta*), रमयंति (*ramayaṃti*), the words "with hymns" to be supplied) at the separation (वियुता (*viyutā*)) from sleep (ससस्य (*sasasya*)), that is, at dawn; in the place (धामन् (*dhāman*)) of water (ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)), in every sacrifice (सस्मिन्नूधन् (*sasminnūdhan*)). That Agni is great, to whom oblations are given with homage (नमसा

(*namasā*)), truthful (ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*)); for the sacrifice (अध्वराय (*adhvarāya*)), the sacrifice performed by the sacrificers, he always (सदमित् (*sadamit*)) वेः (*veḥ*), that is, "knows" (वेत्ति (*vetti*), जानाति (*jānāti*)). The fourth-case ending here stands in the sense of the second, by the statement quoted.

Or else: the gods, Indra and others—

(Continuing the alternative:) the gods delight, in the sacrifice served by the priests, in the worshipful (भजनीय (*bhajanīya*)) place of truth (ऋतस्य सत्यस्य (*ṛtasya satyasya*)), the womb (*yonau*).?427 The great Agni, to whom the oblation is given with homage, i.e. with the oblation, who is truthful, for the sake of the sacrifice, always becomes वेः (*veḥ*), a goer; or he desires the sacrifice (अध्वराय यज्ञं वेः कामयते वा (*adhvarāya yajñaṃ veḥ kāmayate vā*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- यं (*yaṃ*)—which Agni
- देवाः (*devāḥ*)—the praisers
- ससस्य (*sasasya*)—of sleep (the state of slumber)
- वियुता (*viyutā*)—at the time of its ending (at dawn)
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of water
- धामन् (*dhāman*)—near
- सस्मिन् ऊधन् (*sasmin ūdhan*)—at the time of every sacrifice
- रणयंत (*raṇayaṃta*)—they worship (such a one)
- महान् (*mahān*)—the one of mighty form
- नमसा (*namasā*)—with praise
- रातहव्यः (*rātahavyaḥ*)—the one to whom the oblation is offered
- ऋतावा (*ṛtāvā*)—the truthful one
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—always
- अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)—the sacrifice
- वेः (*veḥ*)—knows

Gist

The Agni whom the praisers worship at dawn, near the water, at the time of every sacrifice, that Agni, of mighty form, truthful, to whom the oblation is offered with praise, always knows the sacrifice.

English translation

Whom, when they desist from slumber, the devout propitiate in the abode of water at every sacrifice : the mighty Agni, to whom oblations are to be offered with reverence, who, truthful always, accepts the sacrifice.

Special Topics

The use of the five Ṛks of this sūkta beginning ससस्य यद्वियुता (*sasasya yadviyutā*) is, for the triṣṭubh Ṛks, at the time of the Prātaranuvāka and of the recitation of the Āśvina-śastra mantras, as it is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana-śrauta-sūtra ससस्य यद्वियुतेति पंच (*sasasya yadviyuteti paṃca*) (Ā. 8-13).[?428]

Sāyaṇa has explained this Ṛk in another way also: Indra and the other gods delight in the sacrifice that is performed by the priests and in which Agni is the principal figure. In that sacrifice the very great Agni always comes to the sacrificial ground in order to accept the oblation given by the sacrificer, and he also desires the sacrifice.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वेर॑ध्व॒रस्य॑ दू॒त्या॑नि वि॒द्वानु॒भे अ॒न्ता रोद॑सी संचिकि॒त्वान् ।
दू॒त ई॑यसे प्र॒दिव॑ उरा॒णो वि॒दुष्ट॑रो दि॒व आ॒रोध॑नानि ॥ ८ ॥

> *veradhvarasya dūtyāni vidvānubhe antā rodasī saṃcikitvān |*
> *dūta īyase pradiva urāṇo viduṣṭaro diva ārodhanāni ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वेः । अध्वरस्य । दूत्यानि । विद्वान् । उभे इति । अंतरिति । रोदसी इति । संचिकित्वान् ।
> दूतः । ईयसे । प्रदिवः । उराणः । विदुःतरः । दिवः । आरोधननानि ॥ ८ ॥

> *veḥ | adhvarasya | dūtyāni | vidvān | ubhe iti | aṃtariti | rodasī iti | saṃcikitvān |*
> *dūtaḥ | īyase | pradivaḥ | urāṇaḥ | viduḥtaraḥ | divaḥ | ārodhananāni ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने विद्वान् सर्वं जानानस्त्वमध्वरस्य यज्ञस्य संबंधीनि दूत्यानि
> दूतकर्माणि वेः । वेत्सि कामयसे वा । यद्वा । वेरिति यज्ञविशेषणं ।
> वेर्यजमानस्याभीष्टफलजनकस्याध्वरस्य यागस्य संबंधीनि दूत्यानि दूतकर्माणि विद्वान्
> जानन् उभे रोदसी उभयो रोदस्कोर्द्यानापृथिव्योरंतर्मध्ये स्थितमंतरिक्षं संचिकित्वान् सम्यक्
> जानन् प्रदिवः पुराणः । पुराणानामेदं प्रश्नं प्रदिव
> इति पुराणनामसु पाठात् । उराणोल्पमपि हविरुरु बहुकुर्वाणः । उराण
> उरु कुर्वाण इति यास्केनोक्तत्वात् । विदुष्टरो विद्वत्तरो देवानां दूतस्त्वं
> दिवः स्वर्गस्यारोधनान्यारोहणानि । आरोहणार्हाणि स्थानानीत्यर्थः । देवानां
> हवींष्यर्पयितुमीयसे । गच्छसि ॥

> *he agne vidvān sarvaṃ jānānastvamadhvarasya yajñasya saṃbaṃdhīni dūtyāni*
> *dūtakarmāṇi veḥ | vetsi kāmayase vā | yadvā | veriti yajñaviśeṣaṇaṃ |*
> *veryajamānasyābhīṣṭaphalajanakasyādhvarasya yāgasya saṃbaṃdhīni dūtyāni dūtakarmāṇi vidvān*
> *jānan ubhe rodasī ubhayo rodaskordyānāpṛthivyoraṃtarmadhyè*
> *sthitamaṃtarikṣaṃ saṃcikitvān samyak jānan pradivaḥ purāṇaḥ |*
> *purāṇānāmedaṃ praśnaṃ pradiva*
> *iti purāṇanāmasu pāṭhāt | urāṇolpamapi haviruru bahukurvāṇaḥ | urāṇa*
> *uru kurvāṇa iti yāskenoktatvāt | viduṣṭaro vidvattaro devānāṃ dūtastvaṃ*
> *divaḥ svargasyārodhanānyārohaṇāni | ārohaṇārhāṇi sthānānītyarthaḥ | devānāṃ*
> *havīṃṣyarpayitumīyase | gacchasi ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you, knowing (विद्वान् (*vidvān*)) everything, वेः (*veḥ*)—you know (वेत्सि (*vetsi*)) or desire (कामयसे (*kāmayase*)) the messenger-offices (दूत्यानि (*dūtyāni*), दूतकर्माणि (*dūtakarmāṇi*)) connected with the sacrifice (अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)). Or else: वेः (*veḥ*) is an epithet of the sacrifice, the sacrifice of the sacrificer, that produces the desired fruit; knowing the messenger-offices connected with that rite, and fully knowing (संचिकित्वान् (*saṃcikitvān*)) both रोदसी (*rodasī*), heaven and earth, and the atmosphere standing between them (अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)). प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*) is "ancient"—पुराणानामेदं प्रश्नं प्रदिव इति पुराणनामसु पाठात् (*purāṇānāmedaṃ praśnaṃ pradiva iti purāṇanāmasu pāṭhāt*), as it is read among the names of the ancient. उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*) is one who makes much even of a small oblation, since Yāska has said उराण उरु कुर्वाण इति (*urāṇa uru kurvāṇa iti*). विदुष्टरः (*viduṣṭaraḥ*) is more knowing. You, the messenger of the gods, go (ईयसे (*īyase*), गच्छसि (*gacchasi*)) to offer the oblations to the gods, to the ascents (आरोधनानि (*ārodhanāni*), *ārohaṇāni*) of heaven (दिवः (*divaḥ*)), that is, the places fit for ascending.

Word-to-word meaning

- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—(O Agni) the all-knowing one
- अध्वरस्य (*adhvarasya*)—of the sacrifice
- दूत्यानि (*dūtyāni*)—the messenger-offices
- वेः (*veḥ*)—knowing them
- उभे रोदसी (*ubhe rodasī*)—both heaven and earth
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—and the atmosphere that lies between them
- संचिकित्वान् (*saṃcikitvān*)—having fully known
- प्रदिवः (*pradivaḥ*)—being ancient
- उराणः (*urāṇaḥ*)—knowing (even a small oblation) as abundant
- विदुष्टरः (*viduṣṭaraḥ*)—of greater knowledge
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—you who are the messenger of the gods
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the world of the gods
- आरोधनानि (*ārodhanāni*)—the places of ascent
- ईयसे (*īyase*)—you climb and travel

Gist

O Agni, the all-knowing, who knows the messenger-offices connected with the sacrifice, who has fully known heaven and earth and the atmosphere that lies between them, who, being most ancient, a little

English translation

You who are all-knowing understand the functions of a messenger (of the gods) at the sacrifice: well informed of both heaven and earth, and the intermediate (firmament), and a most intelligent, ancient, and amplifying envoy, you go up the ascents of heaven.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कृ॒ष्णं त॒ एम॒ रुश॑तः पु॒रो भाश्च॑रि॒ष्ण्व॒र्चि॑र्वपु॑षा॒मिदेक॑म् ।
यदप्र॑वीता॒ दध॑ते ह॒ गर्भं॑ स॒द्यश्चि॑ज्जा॒तो भव॒सीदु॑ दू॒तः ॥ ९ ॥

> *kṛṣṇaṃ ta ema ruśataḥ puro bhāścariṣṇvarcirvapuṣāmidekam |*
> *yadapravītā dadhate ha garbhaṃ sadyaścijjāto bhavasīdu dūtaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कृष्णं । ते । एम । रुशतः । पुरः । भाः । चरिष्णु । अर्चिः । वपुषां । इत् । एकं ।
> यत् । अप्रवीता । दधते । ह । गर्भं । सद्यः । चित् । जातः । भवसि । इत् । ऊं इति ।
> दूतः ॥ ९ ॥

> *kṛṣṇaṃ | te | ema | ruśataḥ | puraḥ | bhāḥ | cariṣṇu | arciḥ | vapuṣāṃ | it | ekaṃ |*
> *yat | apravītā | dadhate | ha | garbhaṃ | sadyaḥ | cit | jātaḥ | bhavasi | it | ūṃ iti |*
> *dūtaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने रुशतो रोचमानस्य ते तव संबंध्यत्रैम । एमञ्शब्देन गमनमार्ग उच्यते । एम वर्त्म कृष्णं कृष्णवर्णं भवति । भास्तव संबंधीनि दीप्तिः पुरः
> पुरस्ताद्भवति । चरिष्णु संचरणशीलमर्चिस्त्वदीयं तेजो वपुषां वपुष्मतां रूपवतां ।
> तेजस्विनामित्यर्थः । एकमिन्मुख्यमेव भवति । यद्यं त्वामप्रवीता अनुपगता यजमाना गर्भं त्वज्ञननहेतुमरणिं दधते ह । धारयंति खलु । स त्वं
> सद्यश्चित्सद्य एव जात उत्पन्नः सन् दूतो भवसीदु । यजमानस्य दूतो भवस्येव ॥

> *he agne ruśato rocamānasya te tava saṃbaṃdhyatraima | emañśabdena gamanamārga ucyate | ema vartma kṛṣṇaṃ kṛṣṇavarṇaṃ bhavati | bhāstava saṃbaṃdhīni dīptiḥ puraḥ*
> *purastādbhavati | cariṣṇu saṃcaraṇaśīlamarcistvadīyaṃ tejo vapuṣāṃ vapuṣmatāṃ rūpavatāṃ | tejasvināmityarthaḥ | ekaminmukhyameva bhavati | yadyaṃ tvāmapravītā anupagatā yajamānā garbhaṃ tvajjananahetumaraṇiṃ dadhate ha | dhārayaṃti khalu | sa tvaṃ*
> *sadyaścitsadya eva jāta utpannaḥ san dūto bhavasīdu | yajamānasya dūto bhavasyeva ‖*

Summary

Addressing Agni, "the shining one", Sāyaṇa explains एम (*ema*) as the path of going; this path of yours is black in colour. Your radiance (भाः (*bhāḥ*)) lies in front. Your moving flame (चरिष्णु (*cariṣṇu*) अर्चिः (*arciḥ*)), your brilliance, is the chief of all embodied, form-bearing, radiant beings. When the sacrificers who have approached you (अप्रवीता (*apravītā*)) hold the "germ" (गर्भं (*garbhaṃ*)), meaning the fire-drill, the cause of your birth, you, born that very moment, become the sacrificer's messenger.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- रुशतः (*ruśataḥ*)—of the shining one
- ते (*te*)—your
- एम (*ema*)—path
- कृष्णं (*kṛṣṇaṃ*)—is of black colour
- भाः (*bhāḥ*)—your radiance
- पुरः (*puraḥ*)—is well known before you

- चरिष्णु (*cariṣṇu*)—having the nature of moving about
- अर्चिः (*arciḥ*)—your flame
- वपुषां (*vapuṣāṃ*)—among those who have a luminous form
- एकं इत् (*ekaṃ it*)—possesses a splendour peculiarly its own
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- अप्रवीताः (*apravītāḥ*)—the sacrificers filled with faith
- गर्भं (*garbhaṃ*)—the fire-drills, which are your begetters
- दधते ह (*dadhate ha*)—hold (do they not?)
- सद्यश्चित् (*sadyaścit*)—at that very moment
- जातः (*jātaḥ*)—born, you
- दूतः भवसि (*dūtaḥ bhavasi*)—become the messenger of the gods

Gist

O Agni, your path, shining one, is black in colour. Your radiance is well known before you. Your moving flame has a splendour peculiarly its own even among all those of luminous form. When the sacrificers filled with faith hold the fire-drills that beget you, you, born at that very moment, become the messenger of the gods.

English translation

Dark is the path of you who are bright ; the light is before you ; your moving radiance is the chief of (all luminous) bodies : when the present (worshippers) take up the germ (in the sticks of attrition) you are speedily generated, and become indeed the messenger (of the sacrifice.)

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒द्यो जा॒तस्य॒ ददृ॑शान॒मोजो॒ यद॑स्य॒ वातो॑ अनु॒वा
ति॑ शो॒चिः ।
वृ॒णक्ति॑ ति॒ग्माम॑त॒सेषु॑ जि॒ह्वां स्थि॒रा चि॒दन्ना॑ दयते॒
वि जम्भै॑ः ॥ १० ॥

> *sadyo jātasya dadṛśānamojo yadasya vāto anuvāti śociḥ |*
> *vṛṇakti tigmāmataseṣu jihvāṃ sthirā cidannā dayate vi jambhaiḥ ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सद्यः । जातस्य । ददृशानं । ओजः । यत् । अस्य । वातः । अनुवाति । शोचिः ।
> वृणक्ति । तिग्मां । अतसेषु । जिह्वां । स्थिरा । चित् । अन्ना । दयते । वि । जंभैः ॥ १०॥

> *sadyaḥ | jātasya | dadṛśānaṃ | ojaḥ | yat | asya | vātaḥ | anuvāti | śociḥ |*
> *vṛṇakti | tigmāṃ | ataseṣu | jihvāṃ | sthirā | cit | annā | dayate | vi | jaṃbhaiḥ ‖ 10‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सद्यो जातस्यारणिनिर्मंथनादनंतरमेवोत्पन्नस्याग्नेरोजस्तेजो ददृशानं । ऋत्विगादिभिर्दृश्यमानं भवतीति शेषः । वातो वायुर्यद्यदास्याग्नेः
> शोचिर्दिप्तिमनु लक्ष्मीकृत्य वाति गच्छति तदा सोऽयमग्निरतसेषु वृक्षसंघेषु
> तिग्मां तीक्ष्णां जिह्वां ज्वालां वृणक्ति ! संयोजयति । स्थिरा चित् स्थिराण्यप्यन्नान्नरूपाणि काष्ठादीनि जंभैस्तेजोभिर्वि दयते । विखंडयति । भक्षयतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *sadyo jātasyāraṇinirmaṃthanādanaṃtaramevotpannasyāgnerojastejo dadṛśānaṃ | ṛtvigādibhirdṛśyamānaṃ bhavatīti śeṣaḥ | vāto vāyuryadyadāsyāgneḥ*
> *śocirdiptimanu lakṣmīkṛtya vāti gacchati tadā so 'yamagnirataseṣu vṛkṣasaṃgheṣu*
> *tigmāṃ tīkṣṇāṃ jihvāṃ jvālāṃ vṛṇakti ! saṃyojayati | sthirā cit sthirāṇyapyannānnarūpāṇi kāṣṭhādīni jaṃbhaistejobhirvi dayate | vikhaṃḍayati | bhakṣayatītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

The energy or brilliance of Agni, born immediately after the churning of the fire-drill, becomes visible (ददृशानं (*dadṛśānaṃ*)) to the priests and others (this is the word to be supplied). When the wind (वातः (*vātaḥ*)), having this Agni's flame as its aim, blows, then this Agni joins his sharp (तिग्मां (*tigmāṃ*)) tongue, that is, flame, to the masses of trees (अतसेषु (*ataseṣu*)). Even firm things, the fuel and such which are his food, he splits apart (वि दयते (*vi dayate*)) with his glowing "jaws" (जंभैः (*jaṃbhaiḥ*)), that is, his flames; the meaning is that he consumes them.

Word-to-word meaning

- सद्यो जातस्य (*sadyo jātasya*)—of Agni, born as soon as the act of churning is done
- ओजः (*ojaḥ*)—the brilliance
- ददृशानं (*dadṛśānaṃ*)—comes within the sight of the priests and others
- वातः (*vātaḥ*)—the wind
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Agni
- शोचिः (*śociḥ*)—the brilliance
- अनु (*anu*)—following
- वाति (*vāti*)—blows (then)
- आतसेषु (*ātaseṣu*)—in the masses of trees
- तिग्मां (*tigmāṃ*)—the sharp
- जिह्वां (*jihvāṃ*)—flame
- वृणक्ति (*vṛṇakti*)—he joins
- स्थिराचित् (*sthirācit*)—even though of very dense form
- अन्ना (*annā*)—the fuel and such, which are of the nature of food
- जंभैः (*jaṃbhaiḥ*)—with his brilliances
- वि दयते (*vi dayate*)—(Agni) burns

Gist

The brilliance of Agni, born as soon as the act of churning is done, becomes visible to the priests and others. When the wind blows following the brilliance of this Agni, he joins a sharp flame to the masses of trees. Even though of very dense form, the fuel and such, which are of the nature of food, Agni burns with his brilliances.

English translation

The light of the speedily-generated is visible, and when the wind fans the flame, he (Agni) spreads his blazing tongue amongst the trees, and with his (glowing) teeth consumes the standing (fuel his) food.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तृ॒षु यदन्ना॑ तृ॒षुणा॑ व॒वक्ष॑ तृ॒षुं दू॒तं कृ॑णुते य॒ह्वो अ॒ग्निः ।
वात॑स्य मे॒ळिं स॑चते नि॒जूर्व॑न्ना॒शुं न वा॑जयते हि॒न्वे अर्वा॑ ॥ ११ ॥

> *tṛṣu yadannā tṛṣuṇā vavakṣa tṛṣuṃ dūtaṃ kṛṇute yahvo agniḥ |*
> *vātasya meḻiṃ sacate nijūrvannāśuṃ na vājayate hinve arvā ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तृषु । यत् । अन्ना । तृषुणा । ववक्ष । तृषुं । दूतं । कृणुते । यह्वः । अग्निः ।
> वातस्य । मेळिं । सचते । निजूर्वन् । आशुं । न । वाजयते । हिन्वे । अर्वा ॥१०॥

> *tṛṣu | yat | annā | tṛṣuṇā | vavakṣa | tṛṣuṃ | dūtaṃ | kṛṇute | yahvaḥ | agniḥ |*
> *vātasya | meḻiṃ | sacate | nijūrvan | āśuṃ | na | vājayate | hinve | arvā ‖10‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यह्वोऽग्निस्त्रिषु क्षिप्रमेवान्नानानि काष्ठादीनि तृषुणा क्षिप्रेण रश्मिसमूहेन ववक्ष । वहति । दहतीत्यर्थः । यहो महान् सोऽग्निस्तृषुमात्मानं दूतुं कृणुते । यजमानदूतं करोति । निजूर्वन् काष्ठानि निःशेषेण दहन्नग्निर्वातस्य वायोर्मेळिं बलं सचते । सेवतेः । आशुं न । अश्वसादी यथाश्वं तथार्ना गमनशीलोऽग्निः स्वरश्मिं वाजयते । वाजिनं बलवंतं करोति। हिन्वे । प्रेरयति च ॥

> *yadyo 'gnistriṣu kṣipramevānnānāni kāṣṭhādīni tṛṣuṇā kṣipreṇa raśmisamūhena*
> *vavakṣa | vahati | dahatītyarthaḥ | yaho mahān so 'gnistṛṣumātmānaṃ dūtuṃ*
> *kṛṇute | yajamānadūtaṃ karoti | nijūrvan kāṣṭhāni niḥśeṣeṇa dahannagnirvātasya*
> *vāyormeḷiṃ balaṃ sacate | sevatèḥ | āśuṃ na | aśvasādī yathāśvaṃ tathārnā*
> *gamanaśīlo 'gniḥ svaraśmiṃ vājayate | vājinaṃ balavaṃtaṃ karoti|*
> *hinve | prerayati ca ‖*

Summary

The Agni who quickly (तृषु (*tṛṣu*)) carries off, that is, burns, his foods, the fuel and such, with a swift (तृषुणा (*tṛṣuṇā*)) mass of rays, that great one (यह्वः (*yahvaḥ*) means mahān) makes himself (तृषुं (*tṛṣuṃ*)) a messenger, the sacrificer's messenger. Burning up the fuel completely (निजूर्वन् (*nijūrvan*)), Agni resorts to the strength (मेळिं (*meḷiṃ*)) of the wind. आशुं न (*āśuṃ na*): as a horse-rider his horse, so the swift-going Agni makes his own ray vigorous (वाजयते (*vājayate*): makes it strong) and urges it on (हिन्वे (*hinve*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- यत् (*yat*)—the Agni who
- तृषु (*tṛṣu*)—quickly
- अन्ना (*annā*)—the fuel and such
- तृषुणा (*tṛṣuṇā*)—with a mass of rays (a flame) that spreads swiftly
- ववक्ष (*vavakṣa*)—carries off
- यह्वः (*yahvaḥ*)—that Agni of great majesty
- तृषुं (*tṛṣuṃ*)—himself
- दूतं (*dūtaṃ*)—as messenger on behalf of the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice
- कृणुते (*kṛṇute*)—makes
- निजूर्वन् (*nijūrvan*)—Agni, burning the fuel completely
- वातस्य (*vātasya*)—of the wind
- मेळिं (*meḷiṃ*)—the strength (the help)

- सचते (*sacate*)—resorts to (desires)
- आशुं न (*āśuṃ na*)—as the rider seated on a horse urges the horse to go swiftly
- आर्वा (*ārvā*)—the Agni who is given to going (spreading), his own ray (flame)
- वाजिनं (*vājinaṃ*)—makes powerful, and
- हिन्वे (*hinve*)—urges on

Gist

Agni, who quickly burns up fuel and such, burning everything with his swiftly spreading flame, takes on the office of messenger on behalf of the sacrificer who performs the sacrifice. While burning the fuel, this Agni desires the help of the wind. As a rider seated on a horse urges his horse to go swiftly, this Agni makes his flame spread quickly.

English translation

When quickly, with rapid (radiance) he has carried off his food, the mighty Agni makes (himself) the fleet messenger (of the worshipper); consuming (the fuel), he allies himself with the force of the wind, and as (a horseman) urges his fast steed, so the rapid-going Agni invigorates and urges (his flames).

Sūkta 8 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> दूतं व इत्यष्टर्चमष्टमं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं गायत्रीछंदस्कमग्निदेवताकं । तथा चानुक्रम्यते । दूतं वोऽष्टौ गायत्रं त्विति ॥ व्यूळ्हे दशरात्रे
> प्रथमे छंदोम इदं सूक्तं जातवेदस्यनिविद्धानीयं । तथा च सूत्रितं । दूतं
> व इत्याग्निमारुतं । आ. ८–९ । इति ॥ इदमादिके द्वे सूक्ते प्रातरनुवाकस्याग्नेये
> क्रत् गौ गायत्रे छंदसि विनियुक्ते । सूत्रितं च । अग्ने पावक दूतं व इति सूक्ते ।
> आ. ४–१३ । इति ॥

> *dūtaṃ va ityaṣṭarcamaṣṭamaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ gāyatrīchaṃdaskamagnidevatākaṃ | tathā cānukramyate | dūtaṃ vo 'ṣṭau gāyatraṃ tviti ‖ vyūlle daśarātre*
> *prathame chaṃdoma idaṃ sūktaṃ jātavedasyanividdhānīyaṃ | tathā ca sūtritaṃ | dūtaṃ*
> *va ityāgnimārutaṃ | ā. 8-9 | iti ‖ idamādike dve sūkte prātaranuvākasyāgneye*
> *krat gau gāyatre chaṃdasi viniyukte | sūtritaṃ ca | agne pāvaka dūtaṃ va iti sūkte |*
> *ā. 4-13 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The eighth sūkta, दूतं वः (*dūtaṃ vaḥ*), of eight ṛks, has Vāmadeva as seer, Agni as deity and Gāyatrī as metre. The Anukramaṇī says: दूतं वोऽष्टौ गायत्रं तु (*dūtaṃ vo 'ṣṭau gāyatraṃ tu*). In the ten-night rite called Vyūḍha, in the first Chandoma day, this sūkta is to be recited as the nivid-type text addressed to Jātavedas. So it is stated in the sūtra दूतं व इत्याग्निमारुतं (*dūtaṃ va ityāgnimārutaṃ*) (Ā. 8-9). This sūkta and the next two are employed, in the Prātaranuvāka recitation, for the Gāyatrī-metre ṛks belonging to Agni's Kratu; so it is stated: अग्ने पावक दूतं व इति सूक्ते(*agne pāvaka dūtaṃ va iti sūkte*) (Ā. 4-13).

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning दूतं वः (*dūtaṃ vaḥ*) is the eighth sūkta in the first anuvāka. It has eight ṛks. Vāmadeva is the seer of this sūkta; Agni is the deity; Gāyatrī is the metre. In the Anukramaṇī it is said: दूतं वोऽष्टौ गायत्रं तु (*dūtaṃ vo 'ṣṭau gāyatraṃ tu*). In the ten-night sacrifice called Vyūḍha, in the first Chandoma, this sūkta is to be recited as the nivid-type text relating to Jātavedas; this is explained by the sūtra दूतं व इत्याग्निमारुतं (*dūtaṃ va ityāgnimārutaṃ*) of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra (Ā. 8-9). And this sūkta and the next are employed, in the recitation of the Prātaranuvāka mantras, for the ṛks in Gāyatrī metre relating to Agni's Kratu; this is explained by the sūtra अग्ने पावक दूतं व इति सूक्ते (*agne pāvaka dūtaṃ va iti sūkte*) of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra (Ā. 4-13).

Particulars

> विवृतवागिरुवुदु. मत्तु ई सूक्तवू मुंदिन सूक्तवू प्रातरनुवाकमंत्रगळ पठनदल्लि आग्निय
> सूक्त—८
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—८ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—८ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—८ ॥
> ऋषि—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—अग्निः ॥
> छंदः—गायत्रि ॥

> *vivṛtavāgiruvudu. mattu ī sūktavū muṃdina sūktavū*
> *prātaranuvākamaṃtragaḷa paṭhanadalli āgniya*
> *sūkta—8*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—8 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—8 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—8 ‖*
> *ṛṣi—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agniḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—gāyatri ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

दू॒तं वो॑ वि॒श्ववे॑दसं हव्य॒वाह॒मम॑र्त्यम् ।
यजि॑ष्ठमृञ्जसे गि॒रा ॥ १ ॥

> *dūtaṃ vo viśvavedasaṃ havyavāhamamartyam |*
> *yajiṣṭhamṛñjase girā ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> दूतं । वः । विश्ववेदसं । हव्यवाहं । अनुत्यं ।
> यजिष्ठं । यंजसे । गिरा ॥ १ ॥

> *dūtaṃ | vaḥ | viśvavedasaṃ | havyavāhaṃ | anutyaṃ |*
> *yajiṣṭhaṃ | yaṃjase | girā ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने विश्ववेदसं । विश्वं समस्तं वेदो धनं यस्यासौ विश्ववेदाः । तं
> सर्वविदं वा हन्यवाहं देवेभ्यो हविषां वोढारनुमर्त्यमनुरणधर्माणं
> यजिष्ठमतिशयेन यष्टारं दूतु देवानां वस्त्वां गिरा स्तुतिरूपया वाचा
> ऋंजसे । यजमानोऽहं प्रसाधयामि । वर्धयामीत्यर्थः । ऋंजतिः प्रसाधनकर्मेति यास्कः ॥

> *he agne viśvavedasaṃ | viśvaṃ samastaṃ vedo dhanaṃ yasyāsau viśvavedāḥ | taṃ*
> *sarvavidaṃ vā hanyavāhaṃ devebhyo haviṣāṃ voḍhāranumartyamanuraṇadharmāṇaṃ*
> *yajiṣṭhamatiśayena yaṣṭāraṃ dūtu devānāṃ vastvāṃ girā stutirūpayā vācā*
> *ṛṃjase | yajamāno 'haṃ prasādhayāmi | vardhayāmītyarthaḥ | ṛṃjatiḥ prasādhanakarmeti yāskaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, विश्ववेदसं (*viśvavedasaṃ*): he whose wealth (*vedaḥ*) is all (विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)) is विश्ववेदाः (*viśvavedāḥ*); or, the all-knowing one. You, the bearer of oblations (हव्यवाहं (*havyavāhaṃ*)) to the gods, deathless (अमर्त्यं (*amartyaṃ*), of a nature not subject to dying), the foremost sacrificer

(यजिष्ठं (*yajiṣṭhaṃ*)), the messenger of the gods: you I, the sacrificer, with speech (गिरा (*girā*)) in the form of praise, ऋंजसे (*ṛṃjase*), that is, I fit out, I exalt. Yāska says that ऋंजतिः (*ṛṃjatiḥ*) is a verb of the sense of fitting out.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्ववेदसं (*viśvavedasaṃ*)—possessing all riches
- हव्यवाहं (*havyavāhaṃ*)—bearer of the oblation
- अमर्त्यं (*amartyaṃ*)—free from the nature of dying
- यजिष्ठं (*yajiṣṭhaṃ*)—most worthy of worship
- दूतं (*dūtaṃ*)—and messenger to the gods
- वः (*vaḥ*)—you
- गिरा (*girā*)—with speech in the form of praise
- ऋंजसे (*ṛṃjase*)—I worship and adorn

Gist

O Agni, you who possess all wealth, bear the oblation, are free from mortality, are the most worthy of worship, and are the messenger to the gods, I worship and adorn with a speech in the form of praise.

English translation

I propitiate you with praise, the messenger (of the gods), the omniscient, the bearer of oblations, the immortal, the chief sacrificer

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स हि वेदा॒ वसु॑धितिं म॒हाँ आ॒रोध॑नं दि॒वः ।
स दे॒वाँ एह व॑क्षति ॥ २ ॥

> *sa hi vedā vasudhitiṃ mahā~ ārodhanaṃ divaḥ |*
> *sa devā~ eha vakṣati ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । हि । वेद । वसुधितिं । महान् । आरोधनं । दिवः ।
> सः । देवान् । आ । इह । वक्षति ॥ २ ॥

> *saḥ | hi | veda | vasudhitiṃ | mahān | ārodhanaṃ | divaḥ |*
> *saḥ | devān | ā | iha | vakṣati ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स हि प्रसिद्ध एवाग्निर्वसुधितिं यजमानाभीष्टफलरूपधनस्य दानं वेद ।
> वेत्ति । महान् प्रभूतोऽग्निर्दिव आरोधनमारोहणं देवानां स्थानं वेत्ति ।
> सोऽग्निरिहास्मिन्यज्ञे देवानिंद्रादीना वक्षति । आवहतु ॥ वहेर्धातोर्लिजर्थे लेटिति
> लेट् । तस्य तिप् । सिब्बहुलं लेटीति सिप् । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमश्च । हो ढ इति
> ढत्वं । ठत्वकत्वषत्वानि । तिङ्ङतिङ इति निघातः ॥

> *sa hi prasiddha evāgnirvasudhitiṃ yajamānābhīṣṭaphalarūpadhanasya dānaṃ veda |*
> *vetti | mahān prabhūto 'gnirdiva ārodhanamārohaṇaṃ devānāṃ sthānaṃ vetti |*
> *so 'gnirihāsminyajñe devāniṃdrādīnā vakṣati | āvahatu ‖ vaherdhātorlijarthe leṭiti*
> *leṭ | tasya tip | sibbahulaṃ leṭīti sip | leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaśca | ho ḍha iti*
> *ḍhatvaṃ | ṭhatvakatvaṣatvāni | tiṅṅatiṅa iti nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

That well-known Agni knows the vasudhiti, the giving of wealth in the form of the fruit desired by the sacrificer. Mighty (mahān, abundant), he knows the ārodhana (ascent) of the sky, the place of the gods. That Agni is to bring (vakṣati, "let him bring") the gods Indra and the others here, to this sacrifice. The verb is the Vedic subjunctive (leṭ) of the root vah.

Word-to-word meaning

- स हि (*sa hi*)—the well-known Agni
- वसुधितिं (*vasudhitiṃ*)—what wealth is desired by the sacrificer
- वेद (*veda*)—knows
- महान् (*mahān*)—he, of great nature

- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—in the atmosphere
- आराधनं (*ārādhanaṃ*)—knows the place of ascent of the gods[?429]
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same Agni
- इह (*iha*)—to this our sacrificial place
- देवान् (*devān*)—the gods
- आ नक्षति (*ā nakṣati*)—let him bring[?430]

Gist

The well-known Agni knows what wealth is desired by the sacrificer. He, of great nature, knows in the atmosphere the place of ascent of the gods. May that same Agni bring the gods to this our sacrificial place.

English translation

The mighty one knows how to bestow the (desired) wealth (upon the worshipper); he knows the ascents of heaven : may he bring the gods hither.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स वे॑द दे॒व आ॒नमं॑ दे॒वाँ ऋ॑ताय॒ते दमे॑ ।
दाति॑ प्रि॒याणि॑ चि॒द्वसु॑ ॥ ३ ॥

> *sa veda deva ānamaṃ devā~ ṛtāyate dame* |
> *dāti priyāṇi cidvasu* ‖ *3* ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । वेद । देवः । आनमं । देवान् । ऋत्ययते । दमे ।
> दाति । प्रियाणि । चित् । वसु ॥ ३ ॥

> *saḥ* | *veda* | *devaḥ* | *ānamaṃ* | *devān* | *ṛtyayate* | *dame* |
> *dāti* | *priyāṇi* | *cit* | *vasu* ‖ *3* ‖

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवो द्योतमानः सोऽग्निरानमं यजमानादीनानमयितुं नमस्कारतुं देवानिंद्रादीन्वेद । क्रमेण वेत्ति । दमे यज्ञगृह ऋतायत ऋतं यज्ञमिच्छते यजमानाय प्रियाणि चिदभीष्टान्यपि वसु वसूनि पश्वादीनि धनानि दाति ।
> ददाति । प्रयच्छति ॥

> *devo dyotamānaḥ so 'gnirānamaṃ yajamānādīnānamayituṃ namaskāratuṃ devāniṃdrādīnveda | krameṇa vetti | dame yajñagṛha ṛtāyata ṛtaṃ yajñamicchate yajamānāya priyāṇi cidabhīṣṭānyapi vasu vasūni paśvādīni dhanāni dāti |*
> *dadāti | prayacchati ‖*

Summary

The shining (deva) Agni knows the gods Indra and the others in due order, as those to whom the sacrificer and others should bow (ānamam). In the house (dama), the sacrificial dwelling, he gives to the sacrificer who desires ṛta, the sacrifice, the dear, desired riches (vasu), cattle and other wealth.

Word-to-word meaning

- देवः (*devaḥ*)—the shining
- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- आनमं (*ānamaṃ*)—worthy of the sacrificers' homage
- देवान् (*devān*)—the greatness of the gods Indra and others
- वेद (*veda*)—has known
- दमे (*dame*)—in the sacrificial house
- ऋतायते (*ṛtāyate*)—to the sacrificer engaged in the sacrificial work
- प्रियाणि चित् (*priyāṇi cit*)—most dear
- वसु (*vasu*)—wealth
- दाति (*dāti*)—gives

Gist

The shining Agni has known the greatness of the gods Indra and the others, who are worthy of the sacrificers' homage. In the sacrificial house he gives the dearest wealth to the sacrificer engaged in the sacrificial work.

English translation

Hc, thc divine (Agni), knows how the gods are to be revernced : to the sincere (worshipper) in his dwelling he gives the wealth that is desired.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स हो॒ता सेदु॑ दू॒त्यं॑ चिकि॒त्वाँ अ॒न्तरी॑यते ।
वि॒द्वाँ आ॒रोध॑नं दि॒वः ॥ ४ ॥

> *sa hotā sedu dūtyaṃ cikitvā~ antarīyate |*
> *vidvā~ ārodhanaṃ divaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । होता । सः । इत् । ऊं इति । दूत्यं । चिकित्वान् । अंतः । ईयते ।
> विद्वान् । आरोधनं । दिवः ॥ ४ ॥

> *saḥ | hotā | saḥ | it | ūṃ iti | dūtyaṃ | cikitvān | aṃtaḥ | īyate |*
> *vidvān | ārodhanaṃ | divaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोग्निर्होता देवानामाह्वाता भवति । सेदु स एवाग्निर्दूत्यं देवानां
> दूतकर्म चिकित्वान् जानन् दिवः स्वर्नस्यारोधनमारोहणमारोहणार्हं
> देवानां स्थानं च विद्वान् जानन् अंतर्दावापृथिव्योर्मध्य ईयते । गच्छति ॥
> ईज् गत् । दिवादिभ्यः श्यन् । तिज्ञतिज इति निघातः ॥

> *sognirhotā devānāmāhvātā bhavati | sedu sa evāgnirdūtyaṃ devānāṃ*
> *dūtakarma cikitvān jānan divaḥ*
> *svarnasyārodhanamārohaṇamārohaṇārhaṃ*

> *devānāṃ sthānaṃ ca vidvān jānan aṃtardāvāpṛthivyormadhya īyate | gacchati ‖*
> *īj gat | divādibhyaḥ śyan | tijjatija iti nighātaḥ ‖*

Summary

That Agni is the hotṛ, the summoner of the gods. That same Agni, knowing (cikitvān) the messenger's office of the gods, and knowing (vidvān) the ascent (ārodhana) of the sky, the place of the gods fit for ascending, goes (īyate) between heaven and earth.

Word-to-word meaning

- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- होता (*hotā*)—is the hotṛ who calls the gods to the sacrifice
- सेदु (*sedu*)—that same Agni
- दूत्यं (*dūtyaṃ*)—the divine messengership
- चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*)—as one who knows
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the atmosphere
- आरोधनं (*ārodhanaṃ*)—the place of ascent
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—as one who knows
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the middle region between heaven and earth
- ईयते (*īyate*)—moves about

Gist

Agni is the hotṛ who calls the gods to the sacrifice. That same Agni, knowing his divine messengership and knowing the place of ascent of the atmosphere, moves about in the middle region between heaven and earth.

English translation

He is the invoker (of the gods), comprehending the deity of (their) messenger ; and, knowing the ascent of the sky, he travels between earth and heaven.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ते स्या॑म॒ ये अ॒ग्नये॑ ददा॒शुर्ह॒व्यदा॑तिभिः ।
य ई॒ं पुष्यं॑न्त इन्ध॒ते ॥ ५ ॥

> *te syāma ye agnaye dadāśurhavyadātibhiḥ |*
> *ya īṃ puṣyanta indhate ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ते । स्याम । ये । अग्नये । ददाशुः । हव्यदातिभिः ।
> ये । ईं । पुष्यंतः । इंधते ॥ ५ ॥

> *te | syāma | ye | agnaye | dadāśuḥ | havyadātibhiḥ |*
> *ye | īṃ | puṣyaṃtaḥ | iṃthate ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ते तव यजमानाः स्याम । भूयाम । त इत्युक्तं । क इत्युच्यते । ये
> यजमाना अग्नये हव्यदातिभिर्हविर्दानैर्ददाशुः । प्रीतिं कुर्वंति । ईमेनमग्निं
> पुष्यंतो वर्धयंतो ये यजमाना इंथते । समिद्धिर्दिप्तियुक्तं कुर्वंति ॥

> *te tava yajamānāḥ syāma | bhūyāma | ta ityuktaṃ | ka ityucyate | ye*
> *yajamānā agnaye havyadātibhirhavirdānairdadāśuḥ | prītiṃ kurvaṃti |*
> *īmenamagniṃ*
> *puṣyaṃto vardhayaṃto ye yajamānā iṃthate | samiddhirdiptiyuktaṃ*
> *kurvaṃti ‖*

Summary

"May we be yours (the sacrificers who belong to you)." Who are they? The sacrificers who please Agni with gifts of oblations (havyadāti), and who, cherishing (puṣyantaḥ, strengthening) this Agni, kindle him (indhate), making him blaze with fuel.

Word-to-word meaning

- ये (*ye*)—those who
- अग्नये (*agnaye*)—for Agni

- हव्यदातिभिः (*havyadātibhiḥ*)—with gifts of oblations
- ददाशुः (*dadāśuḥ*)—bring satisfaction to Agni
- ई (*ī*)—this Agni
- पुष्यंतः (*puṣyaṃtaḥ*)—strengthening[?431]
- ये (*ye*)—who
- इंधते (*iṃdhate*)—make Agni blaze (with fuel sticks)
- ते (*te*)—as such worshippers
- स्याम (*syāma*)—we too shall be

Gist

May we too be those who satisfy Agni with gifts of oblations offered to him, and who make Agni blaze with fuel sticks.

English translation

May we be they who propitiate Agni with gifts of oblations, and who, cherishing him, feed him with fuel.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ते रा॒या ते सु॒वीर्यैः॑ स॒स॒वांसो॒ वि शृ॑ण्विरे ।
ये अ॒ग्ना द॑धि॒रे दुव॑ः ॥ ६ ॥

> *te rāyā te suvīryaiḥ sasavāṃso vi śṛṇvire |*
> *ye agnā dadhire duvaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ते । राया । ते । सुवीर्य्यैः । ससवांसः । वि । शृण्वरे ।
> ये । अग्ना । दधिरे । दुनः ॥ ६ ॥

> *te | rāyā | te | suvīyyaiḥ | sasavāṃsaḥ | vi | śṛṇvare |*
> *ye | agnā | dadhire | dunaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ये यजमाना अग्नाग्नौ ॥ सुपां सुलुगित्याकारः ॥ दुवः परिचर्यां
> दधिरे । धारयंति । कुर्वंतीत्यर्थः । ते ससवांसोऽग्निं संभजमाना राया
> पश्वादिलक्षणेन धनेन वि शृण्वरे । विश्रूयंते । प्रख्यायंते । ते सुवीर्यैः
> शोभनवीयोपेतैः पुत्रादिभिश्च विश्रूयंते ॥

> *ye yajamānā agnāgnau ‖ supāṃ sulugityākāraḥ ‖ duvaḥ paricaryāṃ*
> *dadhire | dhārayaṃti | kurvaṃtītyarthaḥ | te sasavāṃso 'gniṃ saṃbhajamānā rāyā*
> *paśvādilakṣaṇena dhanena vi śṛṇvare | viśrūyaṃte | prakhyāyaṃte | te suvīryaiḥ*
> *śobhanavīyopetaiḥ putrādibhiśca viśrūyaṃte ‖*

Summary

The sacrificers who offer (dadhire, bear, perform) service (duvas) to Agni (agnā, a locative form) — they, serving Agni, become renowned (vi śṛṇvare) through wealth (rāyā) such as cattle, and through sons possessed of excellent vigour (suvīryaiḥ).

Word-to-word meaning

- ये (*ye*)—which sacrificers
- अग्ना (*agnā*)—to Agni
- दुवः (*duvaḥ*)—worship and the like
- दधिरे (*dadhire*)—offer
- ते ससवांसः (*te sasavāṃsaḥ*)—those sacrificers, worshippers of Agni
- राया (*rāyā*)—endowed with wealth such as cattle
- वि शृण्वरे (*vi śṛṇvare*)—become renowned
- ते (*te*)—they
- सुवीरैः (*suvīraiḥ*)—become endowed with vigorous sons[?432]

Gist

The sacrificers who offer worship and the like to Agni, those worshippers of Agni, become renowned, endowed with wealth such as cattle; they become endowed with vigorous sons.

English translation

They are renowned for riches and for progeny, who, venerating Agni, offer him oblations.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्मे रायो॑ दि॒वेदि॑वे॒ सं च॑रन्तु पुरु॒स्पृह॑ः ।
अ॒स्मे वाजा॑स ईरताम् ॥ ७ ॥

> *asme rāyo divedive saṃ carantu puruspṛhaḥ |*
> *asme vājāsa īratām ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्मे इति । रायः । दिवेऽदिवे । सं । चरंतु । पुरुस्पृहः ।
> अस्मे इति । वाजासः । ईरतां ॥ ७ ॥

> *asme iti | rāyaḥ | dive 'dive | saṃ | caraṃtu | puruspṛhaḥ |*
> *asme iti | vājāsaḥ | īratāṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पुरुस्पृह ऋत्विगादिभिरभिलष्यमाणा रायः पश्वादिधनान्यस्मे अस्मासु यजमानेषु दिने दिने प्रतिदिनं सं चरंतु । प्रचरंतो भवंतु ॥ दिव्यब्दादुत्तरस्याः
> सप्तम्याः सुपां सुलुगित्यादिना शेआदेश ऊडिदमित्यादिना च तस्योदात्तत्वं ।
> नित्यवीप्सयोरिति द्विर्भावे सत्युत्तरभागस्यानुदात्तं चेत्यनुदात्तत्वं ॥ वाजासोऽन्नानि चास्मे अस्मानीरतां । यज्ञार्थं प्रेरयंतु ॥

> *puruspṛha ṛtvigādibhirabhilaṣyamāṇā rāyaḥ paśvādidhanānyasme asmāsu yajamāneṣu dine dine pratidinaṃ saṃ caraṃtu | pracaraṃto bhavaṃtu ‖ divyabdāduttarasyāḥ*
> *saptamyāḥ supāṃ sulugityādinā śeādeśa ūḍidamityādinā ca tasyodāttatvaṃ | nityavīpsayoriti dvirbhāve*
> *satyuttarabhāgasyānudāttaṃ cetyanudāttatvaṃ ‖ vājāso 'nnāni cāsme asmānīratāṃ | yajñārthaṃ prerayaṃtu ‖*

Summary

May riches (rāyaḥ), cattle and other wealth, much desired (puruspṛhaḥ) by priests and others, move about (saṃ carantu) among us, the sacrificers, day by day. The words वाजासः (*vājāsaḥ*), foods, are to urge us on (īratām) for the sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुस्स्पृहः (*purussṛhaḥ*)—desired by many
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—wealth such as cattle
- अस्मे (*asme*)—among us
- दिवेदिवे (*divedive*)—every day
- सं चरंतु (*saṃ caraṃtu*)—come and fill
- वाजासः (*vājāsaḥ*)—foods
- अस्मे (*asme*)—us
- ईरतां (*īratāṃ*)—make full of zeal

Gist

May riches such as cattle, desired by many, come and fill us every day. May the wealth of food urge us on and make us full of zeal.

English translation

May riches, envied by many, devolve upon us day dy day, and (abundant) food await us.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स विप्र॑श्चर्षणी॒नां शव॑सा॒ मानु॑षाणाम् ।
अति॑ क्षि॒प्रेव॑ विध्यति ॥ ८ ॥

> *sa vipraścarṣaṇīnāṃ śavasā mānuṣāṇām |*
> *ati kṣipreva vidhyati ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । विप्रः । चर्षणीनां । शवसा । मानुषाणां ।
> अति । क्षिप्राऽइव । विध्यति ॥ ८ ॥

> *saḥ | vipraḥ | carṣaṇīnāṃ | śavasā | mānuṣāṇāṃ |*
> *ati | kṣiprā 'iva | vidhyati ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विप्रो मेधावी । विप्र इति मेधाविनाम विप्रो धीर इति तन्नामसु पाठात् ।
> सोऽग्निः शवसा बलेन । शव इति बलनाम साजः शव इति तन्नामसु पाठात् । मानुषाणां
> मनुसंबंधिनां चर्षणीनां प्रजानां क्षिप्रेव क्षेप्याण्येव विनाशयितुमर्हाणि । दुरितानीति शेषः ।
> अति विद्यति । अति विद्यतु । अतिशयेन नाशयतु ॥

> *vipro medhāvī | vipra iti medhāvināma vipro dhīra iti tannāmasu pāṭhāt |*
> *so 'gniḥ śavasā balena | śava iti balanāma sājaḥ śava iti tannāmasu*
> *pāṭhāt | mānuṣāṇāṃ manusaṃbaṃdhināṃ carṣaṇīnāṃ prajānāṃ*
> *kṣipreva kṣepyāṇyeva vināśayitumarhāṇi | duritānīti śeṣaḥ | ati vidyati |*
> *ati vidyatu | atiśayena nāśayatu ‖*

Summary

विप्रः (*vipraḥ*) means "wise": the Nighaṇṭu reads "vipra" among the names for the wise, and "vipra" and "dhīra" among their names. That Agni acts शवसा (*śavasā*), "by strength"; "śava" is read among the names of strength, and "sājaḥ" and "śavaḥ" among its names. He is to destroy the removable evils (this is the word to be supplied) of the people *mānuṣāṇāṃ carṣaṇīnāṃ*, those connected with Manu, which deserve to be destroyed. अति विध्यति (*ati vidhyati*) is to be read अति विद्यतु (*ati vidyatu*): let him destroy them utterly.

Word-to-word meaning

- विप्रः (*vipraḥ*)—the wise
- सः (*saḥ*)—Agni
- शवसा (*śavasā*)—by his strength
- मानुषाणां (*mānuṣāṇāṃ*)—of those connected with Manu
- चर्षणीनां (*carṣaṇīnāṃ*)—of the people
- क्षिप्रेव (*kṣipreva*)—the sins that deserve to be destroyed

- अति विध्यति (*ati vidhyati*)—let him destroy completely

Gist

May the wise Agni, by his strength, completely destroy the sins, deserving of destruction, of the people who are of human form.

English translation

May the wise Agni entirely obviate by his power the removable (ills) of men, the descendants of Manu.

Sūkta 9 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अग्ने मृळेत्यष्टर्चं नवमं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं गायत्रीछंदस्कमग्निदेवताकं । अनुक्रांतं च । अग्ने मृळेति ॥ द्वितीये छंदोम इदं सूक्तं जातवेदस्यनिविद्धानीयं । सूत्रितं च । क्रीळं वः शर्धोऽग्ने मृळेत्याग्निमारुतं ।
> आ. ८–१० । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु— अग्ने मृळ ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि ऒंभत्तनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि ऎंटु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु देवतॆयु ;
> गायत्री छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—अग्ने मृळ ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. द्वितीय छंदोमदल्लि
> ई सूक्तवन्नु जातवेदस्संबंधवाद निवित्सूक्तवन्नागि पठिसबेकॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—
> क्रीळं वः शर्धोऽग्ने मृळेत्याग्निमारुतं ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ. ८–१०) विवृतवागिरुवुदु.
> सूक्त–९
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—१ ॥ सूक्त—९
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—९ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—८
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः
> देवता—अग्निः
> छंदः—गायत्री ॥

> *agne mṛḷetyaṣṭarcaṃ navamaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ gāyatrīchaṃdaskamagnidevatākaṃ | anukrāṃtaṃ ca | agne mṛḷeti ‖ dvitīye chaṃdoma idaṃ sūktaṃ jātavedasyanividdhānīyaṃ | sūtritaṃ ca | krīḷaṃ vaḥ śardho 'gne mṛḷetyāgnimārutaṃ |*
> *ā. 8-10 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu— agne mṛḷa èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèya anuvākadalli òṃbhattanèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli èṃṭu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu devatèyu ;*
> *gāyatrī chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli—agne mṛḷa èṃdu heḷiruvudu. dvitīya chaṃdomadalli*
> *ī sūktavannu jātavedassaṃbaṃdhavāda nivitsūktavannāgi paṭhisabekèṃdu āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—*
> *krīḷaṃ vaḥ śardho 'gne mṛḷetyāgnimārutaṃ èṃba sūtradiṃda (ā. 8-10) vivṛtavāgiruvudu.*

> *sūkta-9*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—1 ‖ sūkta—9*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—9 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—8*
> *ṛṣi:—vāmadevaḥ*
> *devatā—agniḥ*
> *chaṃdaḥ—gāyatrī ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The ninth sūkta, अग्ने मृळ (*agne mṛḷa*), has eight ṛks. Its seer is Vāmadeva, its deity Agni, its metre Gāyatrī. The Anukramaṇī says: अग्ने मृळेति (*agne mṛḷeti*). In the second Chandoma this sūkta is to be recited as the nivid-sūkta addressed to Jātavedas; it is prescribed by the sūtra क्रीळं वः शर्धोऽग्ने मृळेत्याग्निमारुतं (*krīḷaṃ vaḥ śardho 'gne mṛḷetyāgnimārutaṃ*) (Ā. 8-10). The block then gives the particulars: Maṇḍala 4, Anuvāka 1, Sūkta 9; Aṣṭaka 3, Adhyāya 5, Varga 9; number of ṛks 8; seer Vāmadeva; deity Agni; metre Gāyatrī.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अग्ने॑ मृ॒ळ म॒हाँ अ॑सि॒ य ई॒मा दे॑व॒युं जन॑म् ।
इ॒येथ॑ ब॒र्हिरा॒सद॑म् ॥ १ ॥

> *agne mṛḷa mahā~ asi ya īmā devayuṃ janam |*
> *iyetha barhirāsadam ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अग्ने । मृळ । महान् । असि । यः । ईं । आ । देवयुं । जनं ।
> इयेथ । बर्हिः । आसदं ॥ १ ॥

> *agne | mṛḷa | mahān | asi | yaḥ | īṃ | ā | devayuṃ | janaṃ |*
> *iyetha | barhiḥ | āsadaṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने मृळ । अस्मान् सुखय । स त्वं महानसि । प्रभूतो भवसि ।
> यस्त्वमीमिमं देवयुं देवानां कामयितारं जनं यजमानं बर्हिर्दर्भमासदं यज्ञ आसत्तुमा इयेथ ।
> आगच्छसि ॥

> *he agne mṛḷa | asmān sukhaya | sa tvaṃ mahānasi | prabhūto bhavasi |*
> *yastvamīmimaṃ devayuṃ devānāṃ kāmayitāraṃ janaṃ yajamānaṃ*
> *barhirdarbhamāsadaṃ yajña āsattumā iyetha | āgacchasi ||*

Summary

"O Agni, मृळ (*mṛḷa*)—make us happy. You are महान् (*mahān*), great, abundant; you who come आ इयेथ (*ā iyetha*) to this person ईं जनं (*īṃ janaṃ*), the sacrificer who desires the gods, to sit आसदं (*āsadaṃ*) at the sacrifice on the बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*), the darbha grass."

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—you, who have such greatness
- देवयुं (*devayuṃ*)—who desires the presence of the gods for the sacrifice
- ईं जनं (*īṃ janaṃ*)—towards this sacrificer
- बर्हिः (*barhiḥ*)—on the seat of darbha grass
- आसदं (*āsadaṃ*)—to sit
- आ इयेथ (*ā iyetha*)—you come
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—such a you
- महान् असि (*mahān asi*)—you are great (therefore)
- मृळे (*mṛḷè*)—make us happy

Gist

O Agni, you who come to sit on the seat of darbha grass before this sacrificer, who desires the presence of the gods for the sacrifice, are such a great one. Make us happy.

English translation

Agni, make us happy, for you are mighty, (you) who come to this devout man to sit down on the sacred grass.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स मानु॑षीषु दू॒ळभो॑ वि॒क्षु प्रा॒वीरम॑र्त्यः ।
दू॒तो विश्वे॑षां भुवत् ॥ २ ॥

> *sa mānuṣīṣu dūḷabho vikṣu prāvīramartyaḥ |*
> *dūto viśveṣāṃ bhuvat ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । मानुषीषु । दुःकदभः । विक्षु । प्रअवीः । अमत्यर्तः ।
> दूतः । विश्वेषां । भुवत् ॥ २ ॥

> *saḥ | mānuṣīṣu | duḥkadabhaḥ | vikṣu | praavīḥ | amatyartaḥ |*
> *dūtaḥ | viśveṣāṃ | bhuvat ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> दूळभो दुर्दभो राक्षसादिना दुर्हिंसो मानुषीषु मनुसंबंधिनीषु
> विक्षु प्रजासु प्रावीः प्रकर्षेण गंतामर्त्योऽमरणधर्मा सोग्निर्विश्वेषां
> सर्वेषां देवानां दूतो भुवत् । भवतु ॥

> *dūḷabho durdabho rākṣasādinā durhiṃso mānuṣīṣu manusaṃbaṃdhinīṣu*
> *vikṣu prajāsu prāvīḥ prakarṣeṇa gaṃtāmartyo 'maraṇadharmā sognirviśveṣāṃ*
> *sarvèṣāṃ devānāṃ dūto bhuvat | bhavatu ‖*

Summary

दूळभः (*dūḷabhaḥ*) means दुर्दभो (*durdabho*), hard to harm for Rākṣasas and the like. Among the people *mānuṣīṣu vikṣu*, who are connected with Manu, he is प्रावीः (*prāvīḥ*), one who goes forth pre-eminently. He is अमर्त्यः (*amartyaḥ*), of immortal nature. May that Agni become the messenger दूतः (*dūtaḥ*) of all the gods.[?433]

Word-to-word meaning

- दूळभः (*dūḷabhaḥ*)—he who cannot be resisted even by the Asuras
- मानुषीषु (*mānuṣīṣu*)—connected with Manu
- विक्षु (*vikṣu*)—among the people
- प्रावीः (*prāvīḥ*)—who moves pre-eminently
- अमर्त्यः (*amartyaḥ*)—who is free from mortality
- सः (*saḥ*)—that same Agni
- विश्वेषां (*viśveṣāṃ*)—of all the gods
- दूतः (*dūtaḥ*)—as messenger
- भुवत् (*bhuvat*)—let him be

Gist

May that same Agni, who cannot be resisted even by the Asuras, who moves pre-eminently among the people connected with Manu, and who is free from mortality, be the messenger of all the gods.

English translation

May that Agni, who is difficult to overcome, who is immortal, who is pre-eminent among men the descendants of Manu, become the messenger of all the gods..

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स स॒द्म परि॑ णीयते॒ होता॑ म॒न्द्रो दिवि॑ष्टिषु ।

उ॒त पोता॒ नि षी॑दति ॥ ३ ॥

> *sa sadma pari ṇīyate hotā mandro diviṣṭiṣu |*
> *uta potā ni ṣīdati ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सः । सद्म । परि । नीयते । होता । मंद्रः । दिविष्टिषु ।
> उत । प्रोता । नि । सीदति ॥ ३ ॥

> *saḥ | sadma | pari | nīyate | hotā | maṃdraḥ | diviṣṭiṣu |*
> *uta | protā | ni | sīdati ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सोऽग्निः सद्म यज्ञगृहं परि णीयते । ऋत्विग्निः परितो नीयते । नीयमानः सन् दिविष्टिषु यागेषु मंद्रो मदनीयः स्तुत्यः सोऽग्निर्होता च भवति ।
> उतापि च प्रोता सन्नि षीदति । यज्ञगृह उपविशति ॥

> *so 'gniḥ sadma yajñagṛhaṃ pari ṇīyate | ṛtvigniḥ parito nīyate | nīyamānaḥ san diviṣṭiṣu yāgeṣu maṃdro madanīyaḥ stutyaḥ so 'gnirhotā ca bhavati |*
> *utāpi ca protā sanni ṣīdati | yajñagṛha upaviśati ‖*

Summary

That Agni is led around सद्म (*sadma*), the sacrificial house; the priests lead him round on all sides. While being led, in the दिविष्टिषु (*diviṣṭiṣu*), the sacrifices, he, the delightful and praiseworthy मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*), becomes the Hotṛ. And moreover, as the Potṛ he sits down in the sacrificial house.

Word-to-word meaning

- सः (*saḥ*)—that same Agni
- सद्म (*sadma*)—in the sacrificial house
- परिणीयते (*pariṇīyatè*)—is carried round, gathered on all sides (by the priests)
- मंद्रः (*maṃdraḥ*)—Agni, the attractive and venerable
- दिविष्टिषु (*diviṣṭiṣu*)—in the sacrifices
- होता (*hotā*)—is the Hotṛ
- उत (*uta*)—and
- पोता (*potā*)—as the Potṛ also
- निषीदति (*niṣīdati*)—sits down in the sacrificial house

Gist

The great Agni is carried round on all sides by the priests in the sacrificial house. That same Agni, attractive and venerable, is both the Hotṛ and in the form of the Potṛ.

English translation

He is conveyed into the sacrificial hall as the Hotri to be adored at sacrifices, or as the Potri he sits down (on the sacred grass).

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒त ग्ना अ॒ग्निर॑ध्व॒र उ॒तो गृ॒हप॑ति॒र्दमे॑ ।
उ॒त ब्र॒ह्मा नि षी॑दति ॥ ४ ॥

> *uta gnā agniradhvara uto gṛhapatirdame |*
> *uta brahmā ni ṣīdati ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उत । ग्नाः । अग्निः । अध्वरे । उतो इति । गृहपतिः । दमे ।
> उत । ब्रह्मा । नि । सीदति ॥ ४ ॥

> *uta | gnāḥ | agniḥ | adhvare | uto iti | gṛhapatiḥ | dame |*
> *uta | brahmā | ni | sīdati ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उतापि चाग्निरध्वरे यागे ग्ना देवपत्नीर्यजति । यष्टा भवतीत्यर्थः ।
> यद्वा । ग्ना गच्छन्नध्वर्युर्भवति । उतो अपि च सोऽग्निर्दमे यज्ञगृहे गृहपतिर्यजमानश्च भवति ।
> उतापि च ब्रह्मा ब्राह्मणाच्छंसी सन्नि षीदति । उपविशति ॥

> *utāpi cāgniradhvare yāge gnā devapatnīryajati | yaṣṭā bhavatītyarthaḥ | yadvā | gnā gacchannadhvaryurbhavati | uto api ca so 'gnirdame yajñagṛhe gṛhapatiryajamānaśca bhavati | utāpi ca brahmā brāhmaṇācchaṃsī sanni ṣīdati | upaviśati ‖*

Summary

And Agni at the अध्वरे (*adhvare*), the sacrifice, worships ग्नाः (*gnāḥ*), the wives of the gods; that is, he becomes the sacrificer. Or else: ग्ना (*gnā*), going, he becomes the Adhvaryu. And moreover, in the दमे (*dame*), the sacrificial house, he is the गृहपतिः (*gṛhapatiḥ*), the sacrificer. And also, as ब्रह्मा (*brahmā*), the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin, he sits down.

Word-to-word meaning

- उत (*uta*)—and
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- अध्वरे (*adhvare*)—in the sacrifice
- ग्नाः (*gnāḥ*)—is the Adhvaryu
- उत (*uta*)—and
- दमे (*dame*)—in the sacrificial house
- गृहपतिः (*gṛhapatiḥ*)—is also the sacrificer
- उत (*uta*)—and
- ब्रह्मा (*brahmā*)—as the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin also
- नि षीदति (*ni ṣīdati*)—sits down

Gist

That same great Agni sits down in the sacrifice as the Adhvaryu (or as one who worships the wives of the gods), in the sacrificial house as the sacrificer, and as the Brāhmaṇācchaṃsin.

English translation

Agni may be the officiating priest at the sacrifice, or the master of the house in the sacrificial chamber, or he sits down as the Brahman.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वेषि॒ ह्य॑ध्वरीय॒तामु॑पव॒क्ता जना॑नाम् ।
ह॒व्या च॒ मानु॑षाणाम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *veṣi hyadhvarīyatāmupavaktā janānām |*
> *havyā ca mānuṣāṇām ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वेषि । हि । अध्वरियतां । उपवक्ता । जनानां ।
> हव्या । च । मानुषाणां ॥ ५ ॥

> *veṣi | hi | adhvariyatāṃ | upavaktā | janānāṃ |*
> *havyā | ca | mānuṣāṇāṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अध्वरीयतां यज्ञमिच्छतां मानुषाणां मनुसंबंधिनां जनानां हव्या
> च हव्यानि हविंषि हे अग्ने वेषि हि । कामयसे खलु । उपवक्ताध्वर्युप्रभृतीनां सर्वेषां
> कर्मणामनुज्ञार्थं मां प्रणयेत्यादिरूपस्य वाक्यस्य वक्ता सन्
> ब्रह्मा चासि । ब्रह्मा त्वो वदति जातविद्यां । ऋग्वे. १८–७१–११ । इति श्रुतेः । उपवक्ता
> सर्वेषां कर्मणामवैकल्यार्थमुपद्रष्टा ना सदस्कोऽसि । स हि सप्तदशः
> कर्मणामुपद्रष्टा भवतीत्यापस्तंबेनोक्तत्वात् ॥

> *adhvarīyatāṃ yajñamicchatāṃ mānuṣāṇāṃ manusaṃbaṃdhināṃ*
> *janānāṃ havyā*
> *ca havyāni haviṃṣi he agne veṣi hi | kāmayase khalu |*
> *upavaktādhvaryuprabhṛtīnāṃ sarveṣāṃ karmaṇāmanujñārthaṃ māṃ*
> *praṇayetyādirūpasya vākyasya vaktā san*
> *brahmā cāsi | brahmā tvo vadati jātavidyāṃ | ṛgve. 18-71-11 | iti śruteḥ*
> *| upavaktā sarveṣāṃ karmaṇāmavaikalyārthamupadraṣṭā nā sadasko 'si*
> *| sa hi saptadaśaḥ*
> *karmaṇāmupadraṣṭā bhavatītyāpastaṃbenoktatvāt ‖*

Summary

"Of those desiring a sacrifice, of the descendants of Manu, the people, you desire the oblations, O Agni." He explains वेषि हि (*veṣi hi*) as "you indeed desire". As उपवक्ता (*upavaktā*) you are the speaker of the sentence beginning "lead me forward", given to authorise all the rites of the Adhvaryu and the others, and you are also the Brahmā priest. He cites the śruti ब्रह्मा त्वो वदति जातविद्यां (*brahmā tvo vadati jātavidyāṃ*) (Ṛg. 18-71-11)[?434]. The उपवक्ता (*upavaktā*) is the overseer who watches that no rite is deficient, the member of the assembly, the seventeenth priest, who oversees the rites, as Āpastamba says.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अध्वरीयतां (*adhvarīyatāṃ*)—of those who wish to perform the sacrifice

- मानुषाणां (*mānuṣāṇām*)—of those related to Manu
- जनानां (*janānām*)—of the sacrificers
- हव्या च (*havyā ca*)—the oblations also
- वेषि हि (*veṣi hi*)—you desire, do you not (therefore)
- उपवक्ता (*upavaktā*)—you are also the Upavaktṛ (one who gives permission to sacrificers and priests at the proper time)

Gist

O Agni, do you not desire also the oblations of the sacrificers, who wish to perform the sacrifice and are descendants of Manu? Therefore you are also the Upavaktṛ, who gives permission to the sacrificers and priests at the proper time.

English translation

You, who are the director (of the ceremonial), accept the oblations of devoutly-worshipping men the descendants of Manu.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वेषीद्व॑स्य दू॒त्यं१॒॑ यस्य॒ जुजो॑षो अध्व॒रम् ।
ह॒व्यं मर्त॑स्य॒ वोळ्ह॑वे ॥ ६ ॥

> *veṣīdvasya dūtyaṃ yasya jujoṣo adhvaram |*
> *havyaṃ martasya voḷhave ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वेषि । इत् । ऊं इति । अस्य । दूत्यं । यस्य । जजोषः । अध्वरं ।
> हव्यं । मर्तस्य । वोळ्हवे ॥ ६ ॥

> *veṣi | it | ūṃ iti | asya | dūtyaṃ | yasya | jajoṣaḥ | adhvaraṃ |*
> *havyaṃ | martasya | voḷhave ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने त्वं मर्तस्य मनुष्यस्य यस्य यजमानस्याध्वरं यागं हव्यं
> हविर्वोळ्हवे वोढुं ॥ वहेर्धातोस्तुमर्थे सेसेनस इति तवेन्प्रत्ययः ।
> इत्यादिर्नित्यमित्याद्युदात्तत्वं ॥ जुजोषः सेवेथाः ॥ जुषी प्रीतिसेवनयोः । लेट् ।
> बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुर्द्विर्भावश्च । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः ॥ अस्य यजमानस्य
> दूत्यं दूतकर्म वेषीदु । कामयस एव ॥

> *he agne tvaṃ martasya manuṣyasya yasya yajamānasyādhvaraṃ yāgaṃ havyaṃ*
> *havirvoḷhave voḍhuṃ ‖ vaherdhātostumarthe sesenasa iti tavenpratyayaḥ |*
> *ityādirnityamityādyudāttatvaṃ ‖ jujoṣaḥ sevethāḥ ‖ juṣī prītisevanayoḥ | leṭ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ ślurdvirbhāvaśca | leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ ‖ asya yajamānasya*
> *dūtyaṃ dūtakarma veṣīdu | kāmayasa eva ‖*

Summary

O Agni, of the mortal, the sacrificer, whose sacrifice (अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)) you are pleased with, and whose oblation you are willing to carry (वोळ्हवे (*voḷhave*), to carry), जुजोषः (*jujoṣaḥ*) is "you would serve". Of this sacrificer you desire the messenger's office (दूत्यं (*dūtyaṃ*) = messenger's work); वेषीदु (*veṣīdu*) means "you do desire".

Word-to-word meaning

- मर्तस्य (*martasya*)—of the mortal (O Agni)
- यस्य (*yasya*)—of whichever sacrificer
- अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)—relating to the sacrifice
- हव्यं (*havyaṃ*)—the oblation
- वोळ्हवे (*voḷhave*)—to carry
- जुजोषः (*jujoṣaḥ*)—you desire (for that very reason)
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this sacrificer
- दूत्यं (*dūtyaṃ*)—the messenger's work
- वेषीदु (*veṣīdu*)—do you not desire?

Gist

O Agni, for the sacrificer, a mortal, whose sacrificial oblation you desire to carry, for that same reason do you not also desire to do that same sacrificer's messenger work?

English translation

You are willing (to fulfil) the office of messenger for the mortal whose oblations at the sacrifice you are pleased to convey.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒स्माकं᳚ जोष्यध्व॒रम॒स्माकं᳚ य॒ज्ञम॑ङ्गिरः ।
अ॒स्माकं᳚ शृणुधी॒ हव॑म् ॥ ७ ॥

> *asmākaṃ joṣyadhvaramasmākaṃ yajñamaṅgiraḥ |*
> *asmākaṃ śṛṇudhī havam ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्माकं । जोषि । अध्वरं । अस्माकं । यज्ञं । अंगिरः ।
> अस्माकं । शृणुधि । हवं ॥ ७ ॥

> *asmākaṃ | joṣi | adhvaraṃ | asmākaṃ | yajñaṃ | aṃgiraḥ |*
> *asmākaṃ | śṛṇudhi | havaṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अंगिरोऽग्ने त्वमस्माकमध्वरमस्मदीयं यागं जोषि । जुषस्व ।
> सेवस्व । अस्माकमस्मदीयं यज्ञं यजनसाधनं हविश्च जुषस्व । अस्माकमस्मदीयं
> हवमाह्वानरूपं स्तोत्रं च शृणुधि । शृणु ॥ शृणोतेर्लोण्मध्यमैकवचने सिप् ।
> तस्य हिरादेशे श्नुवः शृ चेति धातोः श्नुप्रत्ययः शृभावश्च । श्रुशृणुष्यकृवृभ्यश्छंदसीति हेर्धिरादेशः
> ॥

> *he aṃgiro 'gne tvamasmākamadhvaramasmadīyaṃ yāgaṃ joṣi | juṣasva*
> *|*
> *sevasva | asmākamasmadīyaṃ yajñaṃ yajanasādhanaṃ haviśca juṣasva*
> *| asmākamasmadīyaṃ*

> *havamāhvānarūpaṃ stotraṃ ca śṛṇudhi | śṛṇu ‖*
> *śṛṇoterloṇmadhyamaikavacane sip |*
> *tasya hirādeśe śruvaḥ śṛ ceti dhātoḥ śnupratyayaḥ śṛbhāvaśca |*
> *śruśṛṇuṣyakṛvṛbhyaścaṃdasīti herdhirādeśaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Angiras Agni, enjoy (जोषि (*joṣi*) = serve) our sacrifice. Enjoy also our यज्ञं (*yajñaṃ*), the means of sacrificing, namely the oblation. Hear our हवं (*havaṃ*), the praise in the form of an invitation.

Word-to-word meaning

- अंगिरः (*aṃgiraḥ*)—O Agni
- अस्माकं (*asmākaṃ*)—our
- अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)—sacrifice
- जोषि (*joṣi*)—enjoy
- अस्माकं (*asmākaṃ*)—our
- यज्ञं (*yajñaṃ*)—the oblation, the means of the sacrifice (enjoy)
- अस्माकं (*asmākaṃ*)—our
- हवं (*havaṃ*)—the praise in the form of an invitation
- शृणुधि (*śṛṇudhi*)—listen and hear

Gist

O Agni, enjoy our sacrifice. Enjoy our oblation, the means of the sacrifice. Hear our praise in the form of an invitation.

English translation

Be pleased by our sacrifice; (be pleased) Angiras, by our offering : hear our invocation.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

परि॑ ते दू॒ळभो॒ रथो॒ऽस्माँ अ॑श्नोतु वि॒श्वतः॑ ।
येन॒ रक्ष॑सि दा॒शुषः॑ ॥ ८ ॥

> *pari te dūḷabho ratho 'smā~ aśnotu viśvataḥ |*
> *yena rakṣasi dāśuṣaḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परि । ते । दुःकदभः । रथः । अस्मान् । अश्नोतु । विश्वतः ।
> येन । रक्षसि । दाशुषः ॥ ८ ॥

> *pari | te | duḥkadabhaḥ | rathaḥ | asmān | aśnotu | viśvataḥ |*
> *yena | rakṣasi | dāśuṣaḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने त्वं येन रथेन विश्वतो विश्वासु सर्वासु दिक्षु गच्छन् दाशुषो
> हविष्पदात्यन्यजमानान्रक्षसि ! विघ्नेभ्यः पालयसि । त्वदीयो दूळभो दुर्दभो

> *he agne tvaṃ yena rathena viśvato viśvāsu sarvāsu dikṣu gacchan dāśuṣo*
> *haviṣpadātyanyajamānānrakṣasi ! vighnebhyaḥ pālayasi | tvadīyo*
> *dūḷabho durdabho*

> दुर्हिंसः स रथोऽस्मान्यजमानान् परि परितः सर्वतोऽश्नोतु । व्याप्पोतु ॥
> अश्नोतेर्वत्ययेन परस्मैपदं ॥

> *durhiṃsaḥ sa ratho 'smānyajamānān pari paritaḥ sarvato 'śnotu |*
> *vyāppotu ‖*
> *aśnotervatyayena parasmaipadaṃ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, the chariot by which you, going in all directions, protect (रक्षसि (*rakṣasi*)) the givers of oblations, other sacrificers, from obstacles: that chariot of yours, दूळभः (*dūḷabhaḥ*), hard to injure, let it pervade us, the sacrificers, on all sides.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- येन (*yena*)—with which chariot
- विश्वतः (*viśvataḥ*)—moving in all directions
- दाशुषः (*dāśuṣaḥ*)—the sacrificers who give oblations
- रक्षसि (*rakṣasi*)—you protect
- ते (*te*)—that of yours

- दूळभः (*dūḷabhaḥ*)—that which cannot be resisted by enemies
- रथः (*rathaḥ*)—that chariot
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us, the sacrificers
- परि (*pari*)—around
- अश्नोतु (*aśnotu*)—let it pervade and be our protector

Gist

O Agni, the chariot of yours with which, moving in all directions, you protect the sacrificers who give oblations, and which cannot be resisted by enemies, let it be around us, the sacrificers, and be our protector.

English translation

May your inviolable car, whereby you defend the donors of oblations, be everywhere around us.

Sūkta 10 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अग्ने तमद्येत्यष्टर्चं दशमं सूक्तं नामदेवस्यार्षमाग्नेयं । तथा
> चानुक्रमणिका । अग्ने तमद्य पदपांक्तं पंचमी महापदपंक्तिरंत्योष्ठिक्
> चतुर्थी षष्ठुपांत्या वा सप्तम्याः पंचकौ मुख्या तृतीयः सप्तको नवकश्चाष्टम्याः पंचकः
> पादश्चतुष्कः सप्तकस्त्रैष्टुभश्चति । इदं कृत्स्नमपि सूक्तं पदपंक्तिछंदस्कं पंचकाश्चत्वारः
> षट्कश्चैकश्चतुर्थश्चतुष्को वा पदपंक्तिरित्युक्तलक्षणोपेतत्वात् । पंचमी तव स्वादिष्टेत्येषा
> महापदपंक्तिः पंच पंचकाः षट्कश्चैक
> इति लक्षणसद्भावात् । अंत्या शिना नः सख्येत्येषोष्ठिक्कृंदस्सा । चतुर्थीषष्टिसप्तम
> आभिष्टे आद्य घृतं न पूतं कृतं चिद्दिष्टेतास्तिस्र उष्णिहः पदपंक्तो वा । अत्र
> सप्तम्यष्टव्योः पदपंक्तुष्टिहोः परिभाषोक्तपादविच्छेदापवादाय प्रकारांतरेण विच्छेदः कृतः ॥
> दशमेऽहनीदं सूक्तमाज्यशस्त्रं । सूत्रितु च । अग्ने तमद्या–

> *agne tamadyetyaṣṭarcaṃ daśamaṃ sūktaṃ nāmadevasyārṣamāgneyaṃ | tathā*
> *cānukramaṇikā | agne tamadya padapāṃktaṃ paṃcamī mahāpadapaṃktiraṃtyoṣṭhik*
> *caturthī ṣaṣṭhupāṃtyā vā saptamyāḥ paṃcakau mukhyā tṛtīyaḥ saptako navakaścāṣṭamyāḥ paṃcakaḥ pādaścatuṣkaḥ saptakastraiṣṭubhaścati |*
> *idaṃ kṛtsnamapi sūktaṃ padapaṃktichaṃdaskaṃ paṃcakāścatvāraḥ ṣaṭkaścaikaścaturthaścatuṣko vā padapaṃktirityuktalakṣaṇopetatvāt |*
> *paṃcamī tava svādiṣṭetyeṣā mahāpadapaṃktiḥ paṃca paṃcakāḥ ṣaṭkaścaika*
> *iti lakṣaṇasadbhāvāt | aṃtyā śinā naḥ sakhyetyeṣoṣṭhikkṛṃdassā | caturthīṣaṣṭisaptama*
> *ābhiṣṭe ādya ghṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ kṛtaṃ ciddiṣṭetāstisra uṣṇihaḥ padapaṃkto vā | atra*
> *saptamyaṣṭavyoḥ padapaṃktuṣṭihoḥ paribhāṣoktapādavicchedāpavādāya prakārāṃtareṇa vicchedaḥ kṛtaḥ ‖*
> *daśame 'hanīdaṃ sūktamājyaśastraṃ | sūtritu ca | agne tamadyā-*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The tenth sūkta, अग्ने तमद्य (*agne tamadya*), of eight Ṛks; seer Vāmadeva; deity Agni. He quotes the Anukramaṇikā on the metres: the whole sūkta is of the padapaṅkti metre, defined as four pādas of five syllables and one of six, or else three of five, one of four and one of six. The fifth Ṛk (तव स्वादिष्ठ (*tava svādiṣṭha*)) is mahāpadapaṅkti: five pādas of five and one of six. The last (शिवा नः सख्या (*śivā naḥ sakhyā*)) is in uṣṇih. The fourth, sixth and seventh (अभिष्टे अद्य (*abhiṣṭe adya*), घृतं न पूतं (*ghṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ*), कृतं चिद्धि (*kṛtaṃ ciddi*)) are uṣṇih or padapaṅkti. In the seventh and eighth the pāda-division is made differently from the general rule. On the tenth day this sūkta is the Ājya-śastra. He cites the sūtra अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरित्याज्यं (*agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairityājyaṃ*).

> श्वं न स्तोमैरित्याज्यं । आ. ८–१२ । इति ॥ पिंडपितृयज्ञेऽग्ने तमद्येत्यनयाग्निं
> प्रत्यागच्छेत् । सूत्रितं च । अग्निं प्रत्येयादग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरिति । आ. २–७
> इति ॥ पौनराधेयिक्यां स्विष्टकृत्येषैव याज्या । सूत्रितं च । अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न
> स्तोमैरिति संयाज्ये । आ. २ ८ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु—अग्ने तमद्य ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हत्तनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि ऎंटु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्के वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु देवतॆयु ; अनु
> क्रमणिकॆयल्लि—अग्ने तमद्य पदपांक्तं पंचमा महापदपंक्तिरंत्योष्णिक् चतुर्थी
> षष्ठ्युपांत्या वा सप्तम्याः पंचका मुख्या तृतीयः सप्तको नवकश्चाष्टम्याः
> पंचकः पादश्चतुष्कः सप्तकस्त्रैष्टुभश्च ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. ई सूक्तद ऋक्कुगळॆल्लवू पद
> पंक्तिश्छंदस्कवु. पंचकाश्चत्वारः षट्कश्चतुर्थश्चतुष्को ना पदपंक्तिः ऎंदरॆ, ऐदैदु
> अक्षरगळ नाल्कु पादगळू आरुअक्षरगळ ऒंदु पादवू इरुव ऋक्किगॆ पदपंक्तिश्छंदस्सॆंदु
> हेसरु ;
> अथवा ऐदैदु अक्षरगळ मूरु पादगळू नाल्कु अक्षरगळ ऒंदु पादवू, आरु अक्षरगळ ऒंदु
> पादवू इरुव छंदस्सिगू पदपंक्तिश्छंदस्सॆंदु हेसरु. ई सूक्तद तव स्वादिष्ठा ऎंब ऐदनॆय
> ऋक्कु महापदपंक्तिश्छंदस्कवु. पंच पंचकाः षट्कश्चैकः ऎंदु इदर लक्षणवु. ऎंदरॆ, ऐदैदु
> अक्षरगळ ऐदु पादगळू, आरु अक्षरगळ ऒंदु पादवू इदरल्लिरुववु. ई सूक्तद शिवा नः सख्या
> ऎंब कॊनॆय ऋक्कु उष्टिक्छंदस्कवु. मत्तु अभिष्टे अद्य, धृतं न पूतं, कृतं चिद्धि
> ऎंब ४, ६, ७ नेय ऋक्कुगळु उष्टिक् अथवा पदपंक्ति ऎंब छंदस्सिनवु. इल्लि पदपंक्तिश्छंदस्क
> वाद एळनॆय ऋक्किगू उष्टिक्छंदस्कवाद ऎंटनॆय ऋक्किगू पादविच्छेदवु परिभाषॆयल्लि
> (छंदस् शास्त्रदल्लि) हेळिरुवंतॆ इल्लदे अपवादवागि प्रकारांतरदिंद पादविच्छेदमाडलागिदॆ.
> यज्ञद हत्तनॆय दिवसदल्लि ई सूक्तवन्नु आज्यशस्त्रमंत्र पठनक्कागि उपयोगिसबेकॆंदु आश्वला
> यनशौतसूत्रद—अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरित्याज्यं ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ. ८–१२) विवृत

> वागिरुवुदु. पिंडपितृयज्ञदल्लि—अग्ने तमद्य ऎंब ऋक्कन्नु अग्निय अभिमुखवागि निंतु पठिसबेकॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—अग्निं प्रत्येयादग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैः ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ. २–७) विवृतवागिरुवुदु. मत्तु पुनराधेयवॆंब इष्टिय स्विष्टकृद्धोमदल्लि अग्ने तमद्य ऎंब ई ऋक्कन्नु याज्यामंत्रवन्नागि पठिसबेकॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरिति संयाज्ये ऎंब सूत्रदिंद विवृतवागिरुवुदु. (आ. २–८).

> *śvaṃ na stomairityājyaṃ | ā. 8-12 | iti ‖ piṃḍapitṛyajñe 'gne tamadyetyanayāgniṃ*
> *pratyāgacchet | sūtritaṃ ca | agniṃ pratyeyādagne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairiti | ā. 2-7*
> *iti ‖ paunarādheyikyāṃ sviṣṭakṛtyeṣaiva yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | agne tamadyāśvaṃ na*
> *stomairiti saṃyājye | ā. 2 8 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—agne tamadya èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèya anuvākadalli hattanèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli èṃṭu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu devatèyu ; anu*
> *kramaṇikèyalli—agne tamadya padapāṃktaṃ paṃcamā mahāpadapaṃktiraṃtyoṣṭik caturthī*
> *ṣaṣṭupāṃtyā vā saptamyāḥ paṃcakā mukhyā tṛtīyaḥ saptako navakaścāṣṭamyāḥ*
> *paṃcakaḥ pādaścatuṣkaḥ saptakastraiṣṭubhaśca èṃdu heḷiruvudu. ī sūktada ṛkkugaḷèllavū pada*
> *paṃktiśchaṃdaskavu. paṃcakāścatvāraḥ ṣaṭkaścaturthaścatuṣko nā padapaṃktiḥ èṃdarè, aidaidu*
> *akṣaragaḷa nālku pādagaḷū āruakṣaragaḷa òṃdu pādavū iruva ṛkkigè padapaṃktiśchaṃdassèṃdu hèsaru ;*
> *athavā aidaidu akṣaragaḷa mūru pādagaḷū nālku akṣaragaḷa òṃdu pādavū, āru akṣaragaḷa òṃdu*
> *pādavū iruva chaṃdassigū padapaṃktiśchaṃdassèṃdu hèsaru. ī sūktada tava svādiṣṭhā èṃba aidanèya*
> *ṛkku mahāpadapaṃktiśchaṃdaskavu. paṃca paṃcakāḥ ṣaṭkaścaikaḥ èṃdu idara lakṣaṇavu. èṃdarè, aidaidu*
> *akṣaragaḷa aidu pādagaḷū, āru akṣaragaḷa òṃdu pādavū idaralliruvavu. ī sūktada śivā naḥ sakhyā*
> *èṃba kònèya ṛkku uṣṭikchaṃdaskavu. mattu abhiṣṭe adya, dhṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ, kṛtaṃ ciddi*

> *èṃba 4, 6, 7 nèya ṛkkugaḷu uṣṭik athavā padapaṃkti èṃba*
> *chaṃdassinavu. illi padapaṃktiśchaṃdaska*
> *vāda eḷanèya ṛkkigū uṣṭikchaṃdaskavāda èṃṭanèya ṛkkigū*
> *pādavicchedavu paribhāṣèyalli*
> *(chaṃdas śāstradalli) heḷiruvaṃtè illadè apavādavāgi*
> *prakārāṃtaradiṃda pādavicchedamāḍalāgidè.*
> *yajñada hattanèya divasadalli ī sūktavannu ājyaśastramaṃtra*
> *paṭhanakkāgi upayogisabekèṃdu āśvalā*
> *yanaśautasūtrada—agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairityājyaṃ èṃba*
> *sūtradiṃda (ā. 8-12) vivṛta*
> *vāgiruvudu. piṃḍapitṛyajñadalli—agne tamadya èṃba ṛkkannu agniya*
> *abhimukhavāgi niṃtu*
> *paṭhisabekèṃdu āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—agniṃ pratyeyādanne*
> *tamadyāśvaṃ na stomaiḥ èṃba*
> *sūtradiṃda (ā. 2-7) vivṛtavāgiruvudu. mattu punarādheyavèṃba iṣṭiya*
> *sviṣṭakṛddomadalli*
> *agne tamadya èṃba ī ṛkkannu yājyāmaṃtravannāgi paṭhisabekèṃdu*
> *āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—*
> *agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairiti saṃyājye èṃba sūtradiṃda*
> *vivṛtavāgiruvudu. (ā. 2-8).*

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the Piṇḍapitṛyajña one should approach the fire with this Ṛk; the sūtra: अग्निं प्रत्येयादग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरिति (*agniṃ pratyeyādagne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairiti*) (Ā. 2-7). In the Sviṣṭakṛt of the Paunarādheyī this is the yājyā: अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरिति संयाज्ये (*agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairiti saṃyājye*) (Ā. 2 8).

Anuvāda

This sūkta, अग्ने तमद्य (*agne tamadya*), is the tenth sūkta in the first anuvāka. It has eight Ṛks. Vāmadeva is its seer; Agni its deity. The Anukramaṇikā says: अग्ने तमद्य पदपांक्तं पंचमा महापदपंक्तिरंत्योष्टिक् चतुर्थी षष्टुपांत्या वा सप्तम्याः पंचका मुख्या तृतीयः सप्तको नवकश्चाष्टम्याः पंचकः पादश्चतुष्कः सप्तकस्त्रैष्टुभश्च (*agne tamadya padapāṃktaṃ paṃcamā mahāpadapaṃktiraṃtyoṣṭik caturthī ṣaṣṭupāṃtyā vā saptamyāḥ paṃcakā mukhyā tṛtīyaḥ saptako navakaścāṣṭamyāḥ paṃcakaḥ pādaścatuṣkaḥ saptakastraiṣṭubhaśca*).

All the Ṛks of this sūkta are in the padapaṅkti metre. पंचकाश्चत्वारः षट्कश्चतुर्थश्चतुष्को ना पदपंक्तिः (*paṃcakāścatvāraḥ ṣaṭkaścaturthaścatuṣko nā padapaṃktiḥ*) means that a Ṛk of four pādas of five syllables each and one pāda of six syllables is called padapaṅkti; or the metre with three pādas of five syllables, one of four and one of six is also called padapaṅkti. The fifth Ṛk of this sūkta, तव स्वादिष्ठा (*tava svādiṣṭhā*), is of the mahāpadapaṅkti metre; its characteristic is पंच पंचकाः षट्कश्चैकः (*paṃca paṃcakāḥ ṣaṭkaścaikaḥ*), that is, five pādas of five syllables and one pāda of six. The last Ṛk, शिवा नः सख्या (*śivā naḥ sakhyā*), is in the uṣṇik metre. The fourth, sixth and seventh Ṛks, अभिष्टे अद्य (*abhiṣṭe adya*), धृतं न पूतं (*dhṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ*), कृतं चिद्धि (*kṛtaṃ ciddi*), are in the metre uṣṇik or padapaṅkti. Here, for the seventh Ṛk, which is padapaṅkti, and the eighth, which is uṣṇik, the division of pādas is made in another manner, as an exception, and not as stated in the parībhāṣā (the science of metre). That this sūkta is to be used on the tenth day of the sacrifice for reciting the Ājya-śastra is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrautasūtra अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरित्याज्यं (*agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairityājyaṃ*) (Ā. 8-12). That in the Piṇḍapitṛyajña the Ṛk अग्ने तमद्य (*agne tamadya*) is to be recited standing facing the fire is explained by the sūtra अग्निं प्रत्येयादन्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैः (*agniṃ pratyeyādanne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomaiḥ*) (Ā. 2-7). And that in the Sviṣṭakṛt-homa of the iṣṭi called Punarādheya this Ṛk is to be recited as the yājyā is explained by the sūtra अग्ने तमद्याश्वं न स्तोमैरिति संयाज्ये (*agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomairiti saṃyājye*) (Ā. 2-8).

> सूक्त-१०
> मंडल——४ ॥ अनुवाक——१ ॥ सूक्त——१० ॥
> अष्टक——३॥ अध्याय——५ ॥ वर्ग——१० ॥
> ॥ सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये——८ ॥
> ऋषिः——वामदेवः ॥
> देवता——अग्निः ॥
> छंदः——१-३, पदपंक्तिः । ४, ६, ७, उष्णिक् पदपंक्तिर्वा ।
> ५. महापदपंक्तिः । ८. उष्णिक् ॥

> *sūkta-10*
> *maṃḍala—4* ‖ *anuvāka—1* ‖ *sūkta—10* ‖
> *aṣṭaka—3*‖ *adhyāya—5* ‖ *varga—10* ‖

> *‖ sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—8 ‖*
> *ṛṣi:—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agniḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—1-3, padapaṃkti: | 4, 6, 7, uṣṇik padapaṃktirvā |*
> *5. mahāpadapaṃkti: | 8. uṣṇik ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अग्ने॒ तम॒द्याश्वं॒ न स्तोमै॒ः क्रतुं॒ न भ॒द्रं हृ॑दि॒स्पृ
श॑म् ।
ऋ॒ध्यामा॑ त॒ ओहै॑ः ॥ १ ॥

> *agne tamadyāśvaṃ na stomaiḥ kratuṃ na bhadraṃ hṛdispṛśam |*
> *ṛdhyāmā ta ohaiḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अग्ने । तं । अद्य । अश्वं । न । स्तोम्यः । क्रतुं । न । भद्रं । हृदिस्पृशं ।
> यध्याम । ते । ओहैः ॥ १ ॥

> *agne | taṃ | adya | aśvaṃ | na | stomyaḥ | kratuṃ | na | bhadraṃ |*
> *hṛdispṛśaṃ |*
> *yadhyāma | te | ohaiḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने अद्यास्मिन्नहनि वयमृत्विगादय ओहैरिंद्रादिप्रापकैः स्तोमैः
> स्तोत्रसमूहैस्तं प्रसिद्धं त्वामृध्याम । समर्धयामः । कीदृशं त्वां । अश्वं न
> वोढारमश्वमिव तथा हविषो वाहकं क्रतुं न कर्तारमिव । उपकर्तारमित्यर्थः ।
> तथा भद्रं भजनीयं हृदिस्पृशं हृदयंगमं । आतिशयेन प्रियमित्यर्थः ॥

> *he agne adyāsminnahani vayamṛtvigādaya ohairiṃdrādiprāpakaiḥ*
> *stomaiḥ*
> *stotrasamūhaistaṃ prasiddhaṃ tvāmṛdhyāma | samardhayāmaḥ |*
> *kīdṛśaṃ tvāṃ | aśvaṃ na*
> *voḍhāramaśvamiva tathā haviṣo vāhakaṃ kratuṃ na kartāramiva |*

> *upakartāramityarthaḥ |*
> *tathā bhadraṃ bhajanīyaṃ hṛdispṛśaṃ hṛdayaṃgamaṃ | ātiśayena priyamityarthaḥ ||*

Summary

O Agni, today, on this day, we, the priests and others, make you prosper with praises (स्तोमैः (*stomaiḥ*), groups of hymns) that convey to Indra and the others (ओहैः (*ohaiḥ*)); you, the well-known. How? Like a horse (अश्वं न (*aśvaṃ na*)), a bearer, so also the carrier of the oblation; like a क्रतुं न (*kratuṃ na*), a doer, that is, a benefactor; and also भद्रं (*bhadraṃ*), worthy of being resorted to, हृदिस्पृशं (*hṛdispṛśaṃ*), going to the heart, that is, exceedingly dear.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अश्वं न (*aśvaṃ na*)—like a horse in carrying our oblations
- क्रतुं न (*kratuṃ na*)—like a benefactor
- भद्रं न (*bhadraṃ na*)—the maker of good fortune
- हृदिस्पृशं (*hṛdispṛśaṃ*)—the dearest to the heart
- तं (*taṃ*)—the well-known
- ते (*te*)—you
- ओहैः (*ohaiḥ*)—(which convey our wishes to Indra and the others)
- स्तोमैः (*stomaiḥ*)—by groups of praisers
- ऋध्याम (*ṛdhyāma*)—we make you prosper

Gist

O Agni, you who are like a horse in carrying our oblations, who are like a benefactor, auspicious, dearest to the heart and renowned, we cause you to grow strong with the groups of praises that carry our wishes to Indra and the other gods.

English translation

We celebrate you to day, Agni, who are like a horse (in conveying our burdens) with your praises, conveying (our wishes to the gods), and (who are) like a benefactor, propitious and affectionate.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अधा॒ ह्य॑ग्ने॒ क्रतो॑र्भ॒द्रस्य॒ दक्ष॑स्य सा॒धोः ।
र॒थीरृ॒तस्य॑ बृह॒तो ब॒भूथ॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *adhā hyagne kratorbhadrasya dakṣasya sādhoḥ |*
> *rathīrṛtasya bṛhato babhūtha ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अध । हि । अग्ने । क्रतोः । भद्रस्य । दक्षस्य । साधोः ।
> रथीः । यतस्य । बृहतः । बभूथ ॥ २ ॥

> *adha | hi | agne | kratoḥ | bhadrasya | dakṣasya | sādhoḥ |*
> *rathīḥ | yatasya | bṛhataḥ | babhūtha ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> पौनराधेयिक्यामिष्टौ प्रधानस्याधा ह्यग्न इत्येषानुवाक्या । एभिनो आर्कैरिति तस्यां स्विष्टकृतोऽनुवाक्या । अभिष्टे अद्येति प्रधानस्य याज्या । सूत्रितं च ।
> अधा ह्यग्ने क्रतोर्भद्रस्याभिष्ठे अद्य गीर्भिर्गृणंत एभिनो आर्कैः । आ. २–८ ।
> इति ॥
> अधा हि इदानीमेव हे अग्ने त्वं क्रतोरस्मदीयस्य यागस्य रथीर्नेता बभूथ । भवसि ॥ छंदसि लुङ्ङिङ्ङट इति भवतेर्वर्तमानेऽर्थे लिटि सिपस्थल् । आर्धधातुकस्येड्वलादेरितीडागमे प्राप्ते बभूथाततंथेति निपातनादिडभावः ॥ कीदृशस्य यागस्य । भद्रस्य भजनीयस्य दक्षस्य प्रवृद्धस्य साधोरभीष्टफलानां साधकस्य ऋतस्य सत्यभूतस्य बृहतो महतः ॥

> *paunarādheyikyāmiṣṭau pradhānasyādhā hyagna ityeṣānuvākyā | ebhino ārkairiti tasyāṃ sviṣṭakṛto 'nuvākyā | abhiṣṭe adyeti pradhānasya yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca |*
> *adhā hyagne kratorbhadrasyābhiṣṭhe adya gīrbhirgṛṇaṃta ebhino ārkaiḥ | ā. 2-8 |*
> *iti ‖*
> *adhā hi idānīmeva he agne tvaṃ kratorasmadīyasya yāgasya rathīrnetā babhūtha | bhavasi ‖ chaṃdasi luṅṅiṅṅaṭa iti bhavatervartamāne 'rthe liṭi sipasthal | ārdhadhātukasyeḍvalāderitīḍāgame prāpte*

> *babhūthātataṃtheti nipātanādiḍabhāvaḥ ‖ kīdṛśasya yāgasya | bhadrasya bhajanīyasya dakṣasya pravṛddhasya sādhorabhīṣṭaphalānāṃ sādhakasya ṛtasya satyabhūtasya bṛhato mahataḥ ‖*

Summary

In the Paunarādheyikī iṣṭi, this verse अधा ह्यग्न (*adhā hyagna*) is the anuvākyā of the principal offering. In the same iṣṭi एभिनो आर्कैः (*ebhino ārkaiḥ*) is the anuvākyā of the Sviṣṭakṛt offering, and अभिष्टे अद्य (*abhiṣṭe adya*) is the yājyā of the principal offering. This is stated in the sūtra (Ā. 2-8) that lists the three verses together.

Meaning: "Now, at this very moment, O Agni, you have become (बभूथ (*babhūtha*), "you are") the leader (रथीः (*rathīḥ*)) of our sacrifice (क्रतोः (*kratoḥ*))." Of what kind of sacrifice? It is भद्रस्य (*bhadrasya*), worthy to be resorted to; दक्षस्य (*dakṣasya*), grown strong; साधोः (*sādhoḥ*), accomplishing the desired fruits; ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*), true; बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*), great. (The rest is the derivation of बभूथ (*babhūtha*): perfect for the present sense, with the augment omitted by irregular formation.)

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अधा हि (*adhā hi*)—at this very moment
- भद्रस्य (*bhadrasya*)—of the auspicious
- दक्षस्य (*dakṣasya*)—of the grown strong
- साधोः (*sādhoḥ*)—of the one that accomplishes our desired ends
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—of the great
- ऋतस्य (*ṛtasya*)—of the true
- क्रतोः (*kratoḥ*)—of the sacrifice
- रथीः (*rathīḥ*)—as leader
- बभूथ (*babhūtha*)—be one who has become (the leader)

Gist

O Agni, at this very moment be the leader of the sacrifice performed by us, which is auspicious, grown strong, accomplishing our desired ends, great and true.

English translation

Be now the conveyer, Agni, of our auspicious, powerful, efficacious, truthful, and great sacrifice.

Special Topics

In the principal homa of the Punarādheyeṣṭi, this verse beginning अधा ह्यग्ने (*adhā hyagne*) is to be used as the puroranuvākyā mantra. In the same iṣṭi the verse एभिर्नो अर्कैः (*ebhirno arkaiḥ*) (the third verse) is to be used as the anuvākyā mantra in the Sviṣṭakṛt homa, and अभिष्टे अद्य (*abhiṣṭe adya*) (the fourth verse) as the yājyā mantra. This is set out in the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrautasūtra (2-8): अधा ह्यग्ने क्रतोर्भद्रस्याभिष्टे अद्य गीर्भिर्गृणंत एभिर्नो अर्कैः (*adhā hyagne kratorbhadrasyābhiṣṭe adya gīrbhirgṛṇaṃta ebhirno arkaiḥ*).

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒भिर्नो॑ अ॒र्कैर्भवा॑ नो अ॒र्वाङ्स्व॒१॑र्ण ज्योति॑ः ।
अग्ने॒ विश्वे॑भिः सु॒मना॒ अनी॑कैः ॥ ३ ॥

> *ebhirno arkairbhavā no arvāṅsvarṇa jyotiḥ |*
> *agne viśvebhiḥ sumanā anīkaiḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एभिः । नः । अर्कैः । भव । नः । अर्वाज् । स्वः । न । ज्योतिः ।
> अग्ने । विश्वेभिः । सुमनाः । अनीकैः ॥ ३ ॥

> *ebhiḥ | naḥ | arkaiḥ | bhava | naḥ | arvāj | svaḥ | na | jyotiḥ |*
> *agne | viśvebhiḥ | sumanāḥ | anīkaiḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने ज्योतिर्ज्योतिष्मान् स्वर्ण सूर्य इव तथा विश्वेभिर्विश्वैः समस्मैरनीकैस्तेजोभिः सुमनाः शोभनमनस्कस्त्वं नोऽस्मदीयैरेभिरेतैरर्कैरर्चनीयैः स्तोत्रैर्नोऽस्माकमर्वाजभिमुखो भव ॥

> *he agne jyotirjyotiṣmān svarṇa sūrya iva tathā viśvebhirviśvaiḥ samasmairanīkaistejobhiḥ sumanāḥ śobhanamanaskastvaṃ no 'smadīyairebhiretairarkairarcanīyaiḥ stotrairno 'smākamarvājabhimukho bhava ‖*

Summary

O Agni, you who are ज्योतिः (*jyotiḥ*), full of light, like the sun (स्वः (*svaḥ*)), and who are सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*), of good mind, together with all (विश्वेभिः (*viśvebhiḥ*)) your splendours (अनीकैः (*anīkaiḥ*)): be turned towards us (अर्वाज् (*arvāj*), "facing") with these (एभिः (*ebhiḥ*)) our hymns of praise (अर्कैः (*arkaiḥ*), "to be worshipped with").

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- स्वः न (*svaḥ na*)—like the sun
- ज्योतिः (*jyotiḥ*)—you who are of the nature of light
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- एभिः अर्कैः (*ebhiḥ arkaiḥ*)—by these praises, which are the means of worship
- सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*)—having a good mind
- विश्वेभिः (*viśvebhiḥ*)—with all
- अनैकैः (*anaikaiḥ*)—splendours, joined also
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- अर्वाज् (*arvāj*)—facing us
- भव (*bhava*)—be

Gist

O Agni, you who are of the nature of light like the sun, with a good mind through these praises of ours, which are the means of worship, and joined with all your splendours, be turned towards us.

English translation

Agni, who like the sun are light, propitiated by these our hymns, come to our presence with all your hosts (of radiance).

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒भिष्टे॑ अ॒द्य गी॒र्भिर्गृ॒णन्तोऽग्ने॒ दाशे॑म ।
प्र ते॑ दि॒वो न स्त॑नयन्ति॒ शुष्माः॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *ābhiṣṭe adya gīrbhirgṛṇanto 'gne dāśema |*
> *pra te divo na stanayanti śuṣmāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अभिः । ते । अद्य । गीःऽभिः । गृणंतः । अग्ने । दाशेम ।
> प्र । ते । दिवः । न । स्तनयंति । शुष्माः ॥ ४ ॥

> *abhiḥ | te | adya | gīḥ 'bhiḥ | gṛṇaṃtaḥ | agne | dāśema |*
> *pra | te | divaḥ | na | stanayaṃti | śuṣmāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अद्यास्मिन्दिवसे हे अग्ने अभिर्गिर्भिः स्तुतिरूपाभिर्वाग्भिर्गृणंतस्तां
> स्तुवंतो वयमृत्विगादयस्ते तुभ्यं दाशेम । हवींषि दद्याम । दिवो न

> *adyāsmindivase he agne abhirgirbhiḥ stutirūpābhirvāgbhirgṛṇaṃtastāṃ stuvaṃto vayamṛtvigādayaste tubhyaṃ dāśema | havīṃṣi dadyāma | divo na*

> सूर्यस्य रश्मय इव ते त्वदीयाः शुष्माः शोधका ज्वालाः प्र स्तनयंति । प्रकर्षण शब्दायंते ।
> यद्वा । दिवो न मेघा इव त्वदीया ज्वालाः शब्दायंते ॥

> *sūryasya raśmaya iva te tvadīyāḥ śuṣmāḥ śodhakā jvālāḥ pra stanayaṃti | prakarṣaṇa śabdāyaṃte | yadvā | divo na meghā iva tvadīyā jvālāḥ śabdāyaṃte ‖*

Summary

Today, O Agni, we, the priests and others, praising you with words in the form of praise (गीर्भिः (*gīrbhiḥ*)), would give (दाशेम (*dāśema*)) you oblations. (The explanation of the simile दिवो न (*divo na*) continues on the next page.)

दिवो न (*divo na*): like the rays of the sun, your शुष्माः (*śuṣmāḥ*), your purifying flames, roar (प्र स्तनयंति (*pra stanayaṃti*)) mightily. Or else: like the clouds of the sky, your flames make a sound.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- अद्य (*adya*)—today
- आभिः गीर्भिः (*ābhiḥ gīrbhiḥ*)—with these words that are in the form of praise
- गृणंतः (*gṛṇaṃtaḥ*)—praising you
- ते (*te*)—addressing you
- दाशेम (*dāśema*)—we offer the oblation
- दिवो न (*divo na*)—bright like the rays of the sun
- ते (*te*)—your
- शुष्माः (*śuṣmāḥ*)—purifying flames
- प्र स्तनयंति (*pra stanayaṃti*)—make a very great sound

Gist

O Agni, praising you today with words in the form of praise, we offer oblations addressed to you. Your flames, which are bright like the rays of the sun and are purifying, make a very great sound.

English translation

Glorifying you, Agni, to-day, with these our praises, may we offer you (oblations) : your (flames), bright as those of the sun, roar aloud.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तव॒ स्वादि॒ष्ठाग्ने॒ संदृ॑ष्टिरि॒दा चि॒दह्न॑ इ॒दा चिं॑द॒क्तोः ।
श्रि॒ये रु॒क्मो न रों॑चत उपा॒के ॥ ५ ॥

> *tava svādiṣṭhāgne saṃdṛṣṭiridā cidahna idā cidaktoḥ |*
> *śriye rukmo na rocata upāke ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तव । स्वादिष्टा । अग्ने । संदृष्टिः । इदा ! चित् । अह्नः । इदा । चित् । अक्टोः ।
> श्रिये । रुक्मः । न । रोचते । उपाके ॥ ५ ॥

> *tava | svādiṣṭā | agne | saṃdṛṣṭiḥ | idā ! cit | ahnaḥ | idā | cit | akṭoḥ |*
> *śriye | rukmaḥ | na | rocate | upāke ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने स्वादिष्टा स्वादुतमा प्रियतमा तव त्वदीया संदृष्टिर्दीप्तिरह्न
> इदा चित् दिवसस्येदानीं चाक्तोरिदा चित् । अक्तुरिति रात्रिनाम शवर्यक्तुरूर्म्येति रात्रिनामसु
> पाठात् । रात्रेरिदानीं च । अहोरात्र इत्यर्थः ॥ अन्नू
> व्यक्तिम्रक्षणकांतिगतिष्वित्यस्माद्धातोः किच्चेत्यौणादिकसूत्रेण तुप्रत्ययः तस्य किद्व–

> *he agne svādiṣṭā svādutamā priyatamā tava tvadīyā saṃdṛṣṭirdīptirahna*
> *idā cit divasasyedānīṃ cāktoridā cit | akturiti rātrināma*
> *śavaryakturūrmyeti rātrināmasu pāṭhāt | rātreridānīṃ ca | ahorātra*
> *ityarthaḥ ‖ annū*
> *vyaktimrakṣaṇakāṃtigatiṣvityasmāddhātoḥ kiccetyauṇādikasūtreṇa*
> *tupratyayaḥ tasya kidva-*

> द्भावश्च । तितुत्रेतीट् प्रतिषेधः । अनिदितामित्यु पधानकारलोपः । चोः कुरिति कुत्वं॥
> रुक्मो नालंकार इव श्रिये पदार्थमाश्रयितुमुपाकेंतिके । उपाक इत्यंतिक
> नाम आक उपाक इति तन्नामसु पाठात् । रोचते । राजते ॥

> *dbhāvaśca | titutretīṭ pratiṣedhaḥ | aniditāmityu padhānakāralopaḥ |*
> *coḥ kuriti kutvaṃ‖*
> *rukmo nālaṃkāra iva śriye padārthamāśrayitumupākeṃtike | upāka*
> *ityaṃtika*
> *nāma āka upāka iti tannāmasu pāṭhāt | rocate | rājate ‖*

Summary

O Agni, your संदृष्टिः (*saṃdṛṣṭiḥ*), your radiance, is स्वादिष्टा (*svādiṣṭā*), sweetest, dearest, at every time of the day (*ahna idā cit*) and at every time of the night (चाक्तोरिदा चित् (*cāktoridā cit*)). *aktuḥ* is a name for night, since it is read among the names of night (*śavarī aktuḥ ūrmyā* ...); the meaning is "day and night". (He then gives the derivation of अक्तु (*aktu*) from the root *aṃj* with the Uṇādi affix tu.)

Like an ornament (रुक्मः (*rukmaḥ*)), it shines (रोचते (*rocate*), "is resplendent") उपाके(*upāke*), near, to lend beauty (श्रिये (*śriye*)) to things. उपाक (*upāka*) is a name for "near", since it is read among those names (आक उपाक (*āka upāka*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- स्वादिष्टा (*svādiṣṭā*)—dearest
- तव (*tava*)—your
- संदृष्टिः (*saṃdṛṣṭiḥ*)—radiance
- अह्नः इदा चित् (*ahnaḥ idā cit*)—at every time of the day
- अक्तोः इदा चित् (*aktoḥ idā cit*)—at every time of the night
- रुक्मो न (*rukmo na*)—like an ornament of gold
- उपाके(*upāke*)—close by
- श्रिये (*śriye*)—to adorn all things
- रोचते (*rocate*)—shines

Gist

O Agni, your radiance shines close by, at every time of the day and at every time of the night, like an ornament of gold, to adorn all things.

English translation

Your lovely radiance, Agni, whether by day or by night, shines upon (all objects) like an ornament (to give them) beauty.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

घृ॒तं न पू॒तं त॒नूर॑रे॒पाः शुचि॒ हिर॑ण्यम् ।
तत्ते॑ रु॒क्मो न रो॑चत स्वधावः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ghṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ tanūrarepāḥ śuci hiraṇyam |*
> *tatte rukmo na rocata svadhāvaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> घृतं । न । पूतं । तनूः । अरेपाः । शुचि । हिरण्यं ।
> तत् । ते । रुक्मः । न । रोचत । स्वधावः ॥ ६ ॥

> *ghṛtaṃ | na | pūtaṃ | tanūḥ | arepāḥ | śuci | hiraṇyaṃ |*
> *tat | te | rukmaḥ | na | rocata | svadhāvaḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे स्वधावः । स्वधाशब्दोन्नवाची । अन्नवन्नग्ने पूतं शोधितं घृतं नाज्यमिव तनूस्त्वदीया मूर्तिररेपाः वापरहिता भवति । शुचि शुद्धं हिरण्यं हितरमणीयं ते त्वदीयं तत्पसिद्धं तेजो रुक्मो न भूषणमिव रोचत । रोचते ।
> भासते ॥

> *he svadhāvaḥ | svadhāśabdonnavācī | annavannagne pūtaṃ śodhitaṃ ghṛtaṃ nājyamiva tanūstvadīyā mūrtirarepāḥ vāparahitā bhavati | śuci śuddhaṃ hiraṇyaṃ hitaramaṇīyaṃ te tvadīyaṃ tatpasiddhaṃ tejo rukmo na bhūṣaṇamiva rocata | rocate |*
> *bhāsate ‖*

Summary

O स्वधावः (*svadhāvaḥ*): the word स्वधा (*svadhā*) denotes food; so, O Agni, possessor of food. Your तनूः (*tanūḥ*), your form, is अरेपाः (*arepāḥ*), free from fault (or stain), like घृतं न पूतं (*ghṛtaṃ na pūtaṃ*), purified clarified butter. That well-known radiance of yours, pure (शुचि (*śuci*)) and हिरण्यं (*hiraṇyaṃ*) (beneficial and delightful), shines (रोचत (*rocata*), "is resplendent") like an ornament (रुक्मः (*rukmaḥ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- स्वधावः (*svadhāvaḥ*)—O Agni, possessor and giver of food
- पूतं (*pūtaṃ*)—purified
- धृतं न (*dhṛtaṃ na*)—like clarified butter
- तनूः (*tanūḥ*)—your form, which is of the nature of radiance
- अरेपाः (*arepāḥ*)—is free from sin
- शुचि (*śuci*)—pure
- हिरण्यं (*hiraṇyaṃ*)—beneficial and delightful
- ते (*te*)—your
- तत् (*tat*)—well-known radiance

- रुक्मो न (*rukmo na*)—like an ornament of gold
- रोचते (*rocate*)—shines

Gist

O Agni, possessor and giver of food, your form, which is of the nature of radiance and is like purified clarified butter, is free from sin. Your well-known radiance, pure, beneficial and delightful, shines like an ornament of gold.

English translation

Giver of sustenance, (Agni), your favour is free from fault, like clarified butter : your pure and golden lustre shines like an ornament.

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कृ॒तं चि॒द्धि ष्मा॒ सनै॑मि॒ द्वेषोऽग्न॑ इ॒नो॒षि मर्ता॑त् ।
इ॒त्था यज॑मानादृतावः ॥ ७ ॥

> *kṛtaṃ ciddhi ṣmā sanemi dveṣo 'gna inoṣi martāt |*
> *itthā yajamānādṛtāvaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कृतं । चित् । हि । स्म । सनेमि । द्वेषः । अग्ने । इनोषि । मर्तात् ।
> इत्था । यजमानात् । ऋत्यवः ॥ ७ ॥

> *kṛtaṃ | cit | hi | sma | sanemi | dveṣaḥ | agne | inoṣi | martāt |*
> *itthā | yajamānāt | ṛtyavaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे ऋतावः सत्यवन्नग्ने कृतं चित् यजमानेन कृतमपि सनेमि चिरंतनं ।
> सनेमाति पुराणनाम सनेमि पूर्वमिति पुराणनामसु पाठात् । द्वेषः पापं
> मर्तान्मनुष्याद्यजमानादित्था सत्यं । इत्थेति सत्यनामैतत् अद्धेत्थेति तनामस्नु
> पाठात् । इनोषि हि स्म । प्रेरयस्येव खलु नाशयसीत्यर्थः ॥

> *he ṛtāvaḥ satyavannagne kṛtaṃ cit yajamānena kṛtamapi sanemi ciraṃtanaṃ |*
> *sanemāti purāṇanāma sanemi pūrvamiti purāṇanāmasu pāṭhāt | dveṣaḥ pāpaṃ*
> *martānmanuṣyādyajamānāditthā satyaṃ | ittheti satyanāmaitat addhettheti tanāmasnu*
> *pāṭhāt | inoṣi hi sma | prerayasyeva khalu nāśayasītyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

O ऋतावः (*ṛtāvaḥ*), truthful Agni: कृतं चित् (*kṛtaṃ cit*), even what has been done by the sacrificer, सनेमि (*sanemi*), of long standing; सनेमि (*sanemi*) is a name for "ancient", since it is read among the names of what is ancient (*sanemi pūrvam*). द्वेषः (*dveṣaḥ*), sin, from the mortal, the human sacrificer, इत्था (*itthā*), truly; इत्था (*itthā*) is a name for "truth", since it is read among the names of truth (*addha itthā*). इनोषि हि स्म (*inoṣi hi sma*): you indeed drive it away, that is, you destroy it.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋतावः (*ṛtāvaḥ*)—O truthful one
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- कृतं (*kṛtaṃ*)—done by the sacrificer
- द्वेषः (*dveṣaḥ*)—the sin
- सनेमि चित् (*sanemi cit*)—even though extremely ancient
- मर्तात् यजमानात् (*martāt yajamānāt*)—from that same human sacrificer
- इत्था (*itthā*)—certainly
- इनोषि हि स्म (*inoṣi hi sma*)—you do indeed destroy

Gist

O truthful Agni, the sin committed by the sacrificer, even though it is extremely ancient, you favour (him) and destroy it without fail from that same human sacrificer.

English translation

Truthful Agni, verily you remove from the mortal who institutes (your) worship, whatever sin has been committed (by him) of old-

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

शि॒वा न॑ः स॒ख्या सन्तु॑ भ्रा॒त्राग्ने॑ दे॒वेषु॑ यु॒ष्मे ।
सा नो॒ नाभि॒ः सद॑ने॒ सस्मि॒न्नूध॑न् ॥ ८ ॥

> *śivā naḥ sakhyā santu bhrātrāgne deveṣu yuṣme |*
> *sā no nābhiḥ sadane sasminnūdhan ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> शिवा । नः । सख्या । संतु । भ्रात्रा । अग्ने । देवेषु । युष्टे इति ।
> सा । सः । नाभिः । सदने । हस्मिन् । ऊधन् ॥ ८ ॥

> *śivā | naḥ | sakhyā | saṃtu | bhrātrā | agne | deveṣu | yuṣṭe iti |*
> *sā | saḥ | nābhiḥ | sadane | hasmin | ūdhan ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने नोऽस्मदीयानि सख्या सख्यानि सखित्वानि भ्रात्रा भ्रातृणि भ्रातृसंबंधीनि कर्माणि देवेषु द्योतमानेषु युष्टे युष्मासु ॥ सुपां सुलुगिति सप्तमीबहुवचनस्य शेआदेशः ॥ शिवा शिवानि संतु । मंगलानि भवंतु । सा सखित्वभ्रातृकर्मसंततिः सदने देवानां स्थाने सस्मिन्नूधनि सर्वस्मिन्यज्ञे नोऽस्माकं नाभिर्बंधनं
> भवति ॥

> *he agne no 'smadīyāni sakhyā sakhyāni sakhitvāni bhrātrā bhrātṛṇi bhrātṛsaṃbaṃdhīni karmāṇi deveṣu dyotamāneṣu yuṣṭe yuṣmāsu ‖ supāṃ sulugiti saptamībahuvacanasya śeādeśaḥ ‖ śivā śivāni saṃtu | maṃgalāni bhavaṃtu | sā sakhitvabhrātṛkarmasaṃtatiḥ sadane devānāṃ sthāne sasminnūdhani sarvasminyajñe no 'smākaṃ nābhirbaṃdhanaṃ*
> *bhavati ‖*

> [56] Vol 17.

> *[56] Vol 17.*

Summary

O Agni, our friendly and fraternal rites (सख्या (*sakhyā*) = friendships, भ्रात्रा (*bhrātrā*) = rites connected with brotherhood), directed to you, the shining gods (युष्टे (*yuṣṭe*) = in you; the seventh-case plural takes the substitute शे (*śe*)), be auspicious; may they be blessed. That succession of rites of friendship and brotherhood, in the dwelling (सदने (*sadane*)), the place of the gods, in every sacrifice (सस्मिन्नूधन् (*sasminnūdhan*)), becomes our bond.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- नः (*naḥ*)—done by us
- सख्या (*sakhyā*)—those of the nature of friendship
- भ्रात्रा (*bhrātrā*)—and those with brotherly affection: the rites
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—the shining
- युष्मे (*yuṣme*)—joining you[?435]
- शिवा (*śivā*)—being auspicious
- संतु (*saṃtu*)—let them be
- सा (*sā*)—that same spirit of friendship
- सदने (*sadane*)—the dwelling-place of the gods
- सस्मिन्नूधन् (*sasminnūdhan*)—in all sacrifices
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- नाभिः (*nābhiḥ*)—let it be the maker of connection

Gist

O Agni, may the rites done by us, of the nature of friendship and with brotherly affection, joining you the shining ones, be auspicious. May that same spirit of friendship, in all the sacrifices, the dwelling-place of the gods, be the maker of our connection.

English translation

May our friendly and fraternal attentions to you deities prove fortunate ; for such (attentions shewn) in every sacrifice (form) our security in the spehre (of the gods).

Sūkta 11 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> द्वितीयेऽनुवाक एकादश सूक्तानि । तत्र भद्रं त इति षड्टचं प्रथमं सूक्तं
> नामदेवस्यार्षं तिष्टुप्पंदस्कमग्निदेवताकं । भद्रं षडित्यनुक्रमणिका ॥
> प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोराग्नेये क्रत्ौ त्रैष्टुभे छंदसीदमादिके द्वे सूक्ते विनियुक्ते।
> तथा च सूत्रितं । भद्रं ते अग्न इति सूक्ते । आ. ४–१३ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु––नाल्कनॆय मंडलद ऐरडनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि हन्नॊंदु सूक्तगळिरुववु.
> अवुगळल्लि भद्रं ते ऎंब ई सूक्तवु मॊदलनॆयदु. इदरल्लि आरु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्के
> वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु देवतॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप्छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि––भद्रं षट्
> ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. प्रातरॆनुवाक मत्तु आश्विनशस्त्रमंत्रगळ पठनकालदल्लि आग्नेयक्रतु संबंध
> वाद त्रिष्टुप्छंदस्सिन मंत्रगळिगागि ई सूक्त मत्तु मुंदिन सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु
> आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद––भद्रं ते अग्नि इति सूक्ते ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ ४–१३) विवृत
> वागिरुवुदु.

> *dvitīye 'nuvāka ekādaśa sūktāni | tatra bhadraṃ ta iti ṣaḍṛcaṃ*
> *prathamaṃ sūktaṃ*
> *nāmadevasyārṣaṃ tiṣṭuppaṃdaskamagnidevatākaṃ | bhadraṃ*
> *ṣaḍityanukramaṇikā ‖ prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayorāgneye kratau*
> *traiṣṭubhe chaṃdasīdamādike dve sūkte viniyukte|*
> *tathā ca sūtritaṃ | bhadraṃ te agna iti sūkte | ā. 4-13 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—nālkanèya maṃḍalada èraḍanèya anuvākadalli hannòṃdu*
> *sūktagaḷiruvavu.*
> *avugaḷalli bhadraṃ te èṃba ī sūktavu mòdalanèyadu. idaralli āru*
> *ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè*
> *vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu devatèyu ; triṣṭupchaṃdassu.*
> *anukramaṇikèyalli—bhadraṃ ṣaṭ*
> *èṃdu heḷiruvudu. prātarènuvāka mattu āśvinaśastramaṃtragaḷa*
> *paṭhanakāladalli āgneyakratu saṃbaṃdha*
> *vāda triṣṭupchaṃdassina maṃtragaḷigāgi ī sūkta mattu muṃdina*
> *sūktada viniyogaviruvudèṃdu*
> *āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada--bhadraṃ te agni iti sūkte èṃba sūtradiṃda (ā*
> *4-13) vivṛta*
> *vāgiruvudu.*

Gist of the bhāṣya

In the second anuvāka there are eleven sūktas. Of them the first is भद्रं ते (*bhadraṃ te*), of six ṛks; its seer is Vāmadeva, the deity Agni, the metre Triṣṭubh. The Anukramaṇikā says भद्रं षट् (*bhadraṃ ṣaṭ*). This sūkta and the next are applied, for the Triṣṭubh verses of the Āgneya kratu, at the recitation of the Prātaranuvāka and the Āśvina-śastra. So it is stated in the sūtra भद्रं ते अग्न इति सूक्ते(*bhadraṃ te agna iti sūkte*) (Ā. 4-13).

Anuvāda: In the second anuvāka of the fourth maṇḍala there are eleven sūktas. Of them this sūkta भद्रं ते (*bhadraṃ te*) is the first, with six ṛks. Vāmadeva is its seer, Agni its deity, Triṣṭubh its metre. The Anukramaṇikā says भद्रं षट् (*bhadraṃ ṣaṭ*). The application of this and the next sūkta, for the Triṣṭubh mantras of the Āgneya kratu at the time of reciting the Prātaranuvāka and the Āśvina-śastra mantras, is explained by the sūtra भद्रं ते अग्न इति सूक्ते(*bhadraṃ te agna iti sūkte*) of the Āśvalāyana-śrauta-sūtra (Ā. 4-13).

Particulars

> सूक्त—११
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—२ ॥ सूक्त—११ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—११ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—६ ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—अग्निः ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *sūkta—11*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—2 ‖ sūkta—11 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—11 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—6 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—agniḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

भ॒द्रं ते॑ अग्ने सहसि॒न्ननी॑कमुपा॒क आ रो॑चते॒ सूर्य॑स्य ।
रुशं॑द्दृ॒शे दं॑दृशे नक्त॒या चि॒दरू॑क्षितं दृ॒श आ रू॒पे अन्नं॑म् ॥ १ ॥

> *bhadraṃ te agne sahasinnanīkamupāka ā rocate sūryasya |*
> *ruśaddṛśe dadṛśe naktayā cidarūkṣitaṃ dṛśa ā rūpe annam ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> भद्रं । ते । अग्ने । सहसिन् । अनेकं । उपाके । आ । रोचते । सूर्यस्य ।
> रुशत् । दृशे । ददृशे । नक्तया । चित् । अरूक्षितं । दृशे । आ । रूपे । अन्नं ॥ १ ॥

> *bhadraṃ | te | agne | sahasin | anekaṃ | upāke | ā | rocate | sūryasya |*
> *ruśat | dṛśe | dadṛśe | naktayā | cit | arūkṣitaṃ | dṛśe | ā | rūpe | annaṃ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे सहसिन् बलवन्नग्ने ते त्वदीयं भद्रं भजनीयमनीकं तेजः सूर्यस्योपाके समीपभूते । दिवस इत्यर्थः । आ रोचते । समंताद्दीप्यते । रुशद्रोचमानं दृशे दर्शनीयं तेजो नक्तया चिद्रात्रावपि ददृशे । दृश्यशे । आ
> इत्ययं शब्दश्चेत्यर्थे वर्तते । आ किंच अरूक्षितु स्निग्धं दृशे दर्शनीयमन्नं
> पुरोडाशादिरूपं हवी रूपे रूपवति त्वय्यत्विगादिभिर्हुतं भवति ॥

> *he sahasin balavannagne te tvadīyaṃ bhadraṃ bhajanīyamanīkaṃ tejaḥ sūryasyopāke samīpabhūte | divasa ityarthaḥ | ā rocate | samaṃtāddīpyate | ruśadrocamānaṃ dṛśe darśanīyaṃ tejo naktayā cidrātrāvapi dadṛśe | dṛśyaśe | ā*
> *ityayaṃ śabdaścetyarthe vartate | ā kiṃca arūkṣitu snigdhaṃ dṛśe darśanīyamannaṃ*
> *puroḍāśādirūpaṃ havī rūpe rūpavati tvayyatvigādibhirhutaṃ bhavati ‖*

Summary

O mighty Agni, your auspicious (भद्रं (*bhadraṃ*), to be resorted to) radiance (अनीकं (*anīkaṃ*)) shines all around (आ रोचते (*ā rocate*)) near the sun (उपाके(*upāke*), in proximity), that is, by day. That bright (रुशत् (*ruśat*)), beautiful-to-see radiance is seen (ददृशे (*dadṛśe*)) by night (नक्तया (*naktayā*)) as well. The word आ (*ā*) here has the sense of "and" (च (*ca*)). Moreover the unctuous (अरूक्षितं (*arūkṣitaṃ*)), pleasing food, the oblation in the form of puroḍāśa and the like, is offered by the priests and others in you, the beautiful-formed one (रूपे (*rūpe*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- सहसिन् (*sahasin*)—O mighty
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- ते (*te*)—your
- भद्रं (*bhadraṃ*)—auspicious
- अनीकं (*anīkaṃ*)—radiance
- सूर्यस्य (*sūryasya*)—of the sun
- उपाके(*upāke*)—in the proximity
- आ रोचत् (*ā rocat*)—shines fully by day
- रुशत् (*ruśat*)—that which is bright
- दृशे (*dṛśe*)—and attractive, that radiance
- नक्तयाचित् (*naktayācit*)—by night too
- ददृशे (*dadṛśe*)—appears
- आ (*ā*)—and
- अरूक्षितं (*arūkṣitaṃ*)—beneficial
- दृशे (*dṛśe*)—and attractive
- अन्नं (*annaṃ*)—food in the form of puroḍāśa and the like
- रूपे (*rūpe*)—in you of beautiful form (is offered)

Gist

O mighty Agni, your auspicious radiance shines fully around the sun at the time of day. That radiant and attractive radiance appears at night too. The beneficial and attractive food in the form of puroḍāśa and the like is offered in you, the beautiful-formed.

English translation

Powerful Agni, your auspicious radiance shines upon the proximity of the sun (by day); your bright and visible (lustre) is conspicuous by night, as the bland and pleasing food (of sacrifice, the oblation) becomes manifest in your form.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वि षा॑ह्यग्ने गृण॒ते म॑नी॒षां खं वेप॑सा तुविजात॒ स्तवा॑नः ।
विश्वे॑भि॒र्यद्वा॒वनः॑ शुक्र दे॒वैस्तन्नो॑ रास्व सुमहो॒ भूरि॒ मन्म॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *vi ṣāhyagne gṛṇate manīṣāṃ khaṃ vepasā tuvijāta stavānaḥ |*
> *viśvebhiryadvāvanaḥ śukra devaistanno rāsva sumaho bhūri manma ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वि । साहि । अग्ने । गृणते । मनीषां । खं । वेपसा । तुविजात । स्तवानः ।
> विश्वेभिः । यत् । ववनः । शुक्र । देवैः । तत् । नः । रास्व । सुमहः । भूरि । मन्म ॥

> *vi | sāhi | agne | gṛṇate | manīṣām | kham | vepasā | tuvijāta | stavānaḥ |*
> *viśvebhiḥ | yat | vavanaḥ | śukra | devaiḥ | tat | naḥ | rāsva | sumahaḥ | bhūri | manma ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे तुविजात मथनेनारणिद्वारा यज्ञादिकर्मसु बहुजन्मन्नग्ने स्तवान ऋत्विगादिभिः स्तूयमानस्त्वं वेपसा यज्ञादिकर्मणा । वेप इति कर्मनाम वेषो वेपो विष्टीति कर्मनामसु पाठात् । मनीषां स्तुतिं गृणते कुर्वते

> *he tuvijāta mathanenāraṇidvārā yajñādikarmasu bahujanmannagne stavāna*
> *ṛtvigādibhiḥ stūyamānastvaṃ vepasā yajñādikarmaṇā | vepa iti karmanāma*
> *veṣo vepo viṣṭīti karmanāmasu pāṭhāt | manīṣāṃ stutiṃ gṛṇate kurvate*

> यजमानाय खं यजमानप्राप्यस्य पुण्यलोकस्य द्वारं वि षाहि । विष्य । विमुंचेतृर्थः ॥
> षोंतकर्मणीत्यस्माद्धातोर्लोण्मध्यमपुरुषैकवचनं । सिप् । दिवादिभ्यः श्यन् । तस्य बहुलं
> छंदसीति लुक् । आदेच उपदेशेशितीत्यात्वं । सेर्हिरादेशः । तिङ्ङतिज इति निघातः ॥ हे
> शुक्र दीप्यमानाग्ने त्वं विश्वेभिर्विश्वैः सर्वैः ॥
> बहुलं छंदसीति भिस ऐसभावः ॥ देवैरिंद्रादिभिः सह यत्पश्वादिधनं ववनः । यजमानेभ्यः
> प्रयच्छेः ॥ वनतेर्लेट् । तस्य सिप इतेश्च लोप इतीकारलोपः । बहुलं
> छंदसीति विकरणस्य श्लुः । श्ला पिति द्विर्वचनं । हलादिशेषः । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः।
> यद्वृत्तान्वितमिति निघाताभावः ॥ हे सुमहः शोभनतेजस्काग्ने भूरि प्रभूतं
> मन्म मननीयं तद्धनं नोऽस्मभ्यं रास्व । देहि ॥

> *yajamānāya khaṃ yajamānaprāpyasya puṇyalokasya dvāraṃ vi ṣāhi | viṣya | vimuṃcetṛrthaḥ ‖*
> *ṣoṃtakarmaṇītyasmāddhātorloṇmadhyamapuruṣaikavacanaṃ | sip | divādibhyaḥ śyan | tasya bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti luk | ādeca upadeśeśitītyātvaṃ | serhirādeśaḥ | tijjatija iti nighātaḥ ‖ he śukra*
> *dīpyamānāgne tvaṃ viśvebhirviśvaiḥ sarvèḥ ‖*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti bhisa aisabhāvaḥ ‖ devairiṃdrādibhiḥ saha yatpaśvādidhanaṃ vavanaḥ | yajamānebhyaḥ prayaccheḥ ‖ vanaterlèṭ |*
> *tasya sipa itèśca lopa itīkāralopaḥ | bahulaṃ*
> *chaṃdasīti vikaraṇasya śluḥ | ślā piti dvirvacanaṃ | halādiśeṣaḥ | leṭo 'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ|*
> *yadvṛttānvitamiti nighātābhāvaḥ ‖ he sumahaḥ śobhanatejaskāgne bhūri prabhūtaṃ*
> *manma mananīyaṃ taddhanaṃ no 'smabhyaṃ rāsva | dehi ‖*

Summary

O Tuvijāta, Agni, born in many ways in sacrificial rites through the churning of the araṇi, being praised by the priests and others, you (act) with वेपसा (*vepasā*), that is, with sacrificial and other rites; वेप (*vepa*) is a name of ritual action, since it is read among the names of action: वेषो वेपो विष्टीति कर्मनामसु पाठात् (*veṣo vepo viṣṭīti karmanāmasu* *pāṭhāt*). For the sacrificer who offers praise (मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*) = stuti), the door (खं (*khaṃ*)) of the meritorious world to be attained by the sacrificer,

… open it (वि षाहि (*vi ṣāhi*), release). O Śukra, shining Agni, the wealth of cattle and the like which you, together with all (विश्वेभिः (*viśvebhiḥ*)) the gods, Indra and the others, have given (ववनः (*vavanaḥ*)) to sacrificers: O Sumahas, of fair splendour, that abundant (भूरि (*bhūri*)) and laudable (मन्म (*manma*)) wealth give (रास्व (*rāsva*)) to us.

Word-to-word meaning

- तुविजात (*tuvijāta*)—O Agni, who are born in many forms in sacrifices of many kinds
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- स्तवानः (*stavānaḥ*)—you who are praised by the priests and others
- वेपसा (*vepasā*)—by sacrificial and other rites (through them)
- मनीषां (*manīṣāṃ*)—praise
- गृणते (*gṛṇate*)—to the sacrificer who offers
- खं (*khaṃ*)—the path to heaven
- नि षाहि (*ni ṣāhi*)—be one who opens?[436]
- सुमहः (*sumahaḥ*)—you of excellent radiance
- शुक्र (*śukra*)—O shining Agni
- विश्वेभिः (*viśvebhiḥ*)—all
- देवैः (*devaiḥ*)—with the gods, Indra and others
- यत् (*yat*)—whatever wealth of cattle and the like
- ववनः (*vavanaḥ*)—you have favoured by having it given (to the sacrificers)
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—abundant
- मन्म (*manma*)—and venerable
- तत् (*tat*)—that same wealth
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us also
- रास्व (*rāsva*)—graciously grant

Gist

O Agni, born in many forms in sacrifices of many kinds, you who are praised by the priests and others, be the one who opens the path to heaven for the sacrificer who offers you praise through sacrificial and other rites. O Agni, of excellent radiance and shining, whatever wealth of cattle and the like you have favoured the sacrificers by having it given, together with all the gods, Indra and others, that same abundant and venerable wealth have given to us also.

English translation

Agni, who are engendered repeatedly, and glorified by sacrifice, set open heaven to him who offers you adoration ; resplendent (Agni), bestow upon us that ample and acceptable (wealth), which, radiant (deity), you, with all the gods have given (to other worshippers).

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वद॑ग्ने॒ काव्या॒ त्वन्म॑नी॒षास्त्वदु॒क्था जा॑यन्ते॒ राध्या॑नि ।
त्वदे॑ति॒ द्रवि॑णं वी॒रपे॑शा इ॒त्थाधि॑ये दा॒शुषे॒ मर्त्या॑य ॥ ३ ॥

> *tvadagne kāvyā tvanmanīṣāstvadukthā jāyante rādhyāni |*
> *tvadeti draviṇaṃ vīrapeśā itthādhiye dāśuṣe martyāya ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वत् । आग्ने । काव्या । त्वत् । मनीषाः । त्वत् । उक्था । जायंते । राध्यानि ।
> त्वत् । एति । द्रविणं । वीर्यपेशाः । इत्याधिये । दाशुषे । मर्त्याय ॥ ३ ॥

> *tvat | āgne | kāvyā | tvat | manīṣāḥ | tvat | ukdhā | jāyaṃte | rādhyāni |*
> *tvat | eti | draviṇaṃ | vīryapeśāḥ | ityādhiye | dāśuṣe | martyāya ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> महापितृयज्ञे स्विष्टकृदग्निः कव्यवाहनो यष्टव्यः । तस्य द्वे अनुवाक्ये ।
> तत्र त्वदग्ने काव्येति द्वितीयानुवाक्या । तथा च सूत्रितं । त्वदग्ने काव्या त्वन्मनीषाः
> स प्रत्नथा सहसा जायमानः । आ. २–१९ । इति ॥
> हे अग्ने काव्या काव्यानि हविर्वहनदेवतानयनादीन्यग्नि संबंधीनि कर्माण्याध्वर्यवाणि कर्माणि
> वा त्वद्भवतो जायंते । उत्पद्यंते । मनीषाः स्तुतिरूपा
> वाचस्त्वदेव जायंते । राध्यानि राद्भुं योग्यान्युक्कोत्थानि शस्त्राणि त्वत्त्वत्तो
> जायंते । इत्याधिये । धीरिति कर्मनाम । इत्थेति सत्यनामसु पाठात् सत्यकर्मणे दाशुषे
> हवींषि दत्तवते मर्ताय मनुष्याय यजमानाय वीरपेशाः।
> पेश इति रूपनाम । इदं विक्रांतं रूपं । अत्र लिंगव्यत्ययेन वीरपेशा इति
> रूपं । द्रविणं पश्वादिधनं त्वत्त्वत्त एति । निर्गच्छति । उत्पन्न इत्यर्थः ॥

> *mahāpitṛyajñe sviṣṭakṛdagniḥ kavyavāhano yaṣṭavyaḥ | tasya dve anuvākye |*
> *tatra tvadagne kāvyeti dvitīyānuvākyā | tathā ca sūtritaṃ | tvadagne kāvyā tvanmanīṣāḥ*
> *sa pratnathā sahasā jāyamānaḥ | ā. 2-19 | iti ‖*
> *he agne kāvyā kāvyāni havirvahanadevatānayanādīnyagni saṃbaṃdhīni karmāṇyādhvaryavāṇi karmāṇi vā tvadbhavato jāyaṃte | utpadyaṃte | manīṣāḥ stutirūpā*
> *vācastvadeva jāyaṃte | rādhyāni rādbhuṃ yogyānyukkotthāni śastrāṇi tvattvatto*
> *jāyaṃte | ityādhiye | dhīriti karmanāma | ittheti satyanāmasu pāṭhāt satyakarmaṇe dāśuṣe havīṃṣi dattavate martāya manuṣyāya yajamānāya vīrapeśāḥ|*
> *peśa iti rūpanāma | idaṃ vikrāṃtaṃ rūpaṃ | atra liṃgavyatyayena vīrapeśā iti*
> *rūpaṃ | draviṇaṃ paśvādidhanaṃ tvattvatta eti | nirgacchati | utpanna ityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

In the Mahāpitṛyajña, Agni Sviṣṭakṛt, the bearer of the offerings to the ancestors, is to be worshipped. He has two anuvākyās; of these त्वदग्ने काव्या (*tvadagne kāvyā*) is the second. So it is stated in the sūtra: त्वदग्ने काव्या त्वन्मनीषाः स प्रत्नथा सहसा जायमानः (*tvadagne kāvyā tvanmanīṣāḥ sa pratnathā sahasā jāyamānaḥ*) (Ā. 2-19).

O Agni, the काव्या (*kāvyā*), that is, the rites connected with Agni such as carrying the oblation and conducting the gods, or the rites of the Adhvaryu, are born (जायंते (*jāyaṃte*)) from you. The मनीषाः (*manīṣāḥ*), words in the form of praise, are born from you alone. The राध्यानि (*rādhyāni*), the śastras fit to be accomplished, consisting of uktha, are born from you. इत्थाधिये (*itthādhiye*): धी (*dhī*) is a name of action, and इत्था (*itthā*) is read among the names of truth (इत्थेति सत्यनामसु पाठात् (*ittheti satyanāmasu pāṭhāt*)); so for the mortal, the human sacrificer, of true action, who has given oblations (दाशुषे (*dāśuṣe*)), वीरपेशाः (*vīrapeśāḥ*): पेश (*peśa*) is a name of form, meaning a valorous form (the gender is altered here); and wealth (द्रविणं (*draviṇaṃ*)) of cattle and the like comes forth (एति (*eti*)) from you alone, that is, arises.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- काव्या (*kāvyā*)—all rites connected with the sacrifice
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—from you
- जायंते (*jāyaṃte*)—are born
- मनीषाः (*manīṣāḥ*)—words in the form of praise also
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—are made from you alone
- राध्यानि (*rādhyāni*)—fit to be carried out
- उक्ता (*uktā*)—hymns in the form of uktha also
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—are born from you alone
- इत्थाधिये (*itthādhiye*)—to the one of truthful action
- दाशुषे (*dāśuṣe*)—who offers the oblation
- मर्त्याय (*martyāya*)—the human sacrificer
- वीरपेशाः (*vīrapeśāḥ*)—the form that displays valour
- द्रविणं (*draviṇaṃ*)—and the wealth of cattle and the like
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—from you alone
- एति (*eti*)—flow

Gist

O Agni, all the rites connected with the sacrifice are born from you. The words in the form of praise and the hymns in the form of uktha are born from you alone. The truthful rite the one who has truth, who offers oblations, and for the man, the sacrificer: a form that displays valour and wealth such as cattle flow from you alone.

English translation

The offerings (to the gods) are engendered, Agni, of you; from you (proceed) praises; from you effective prayers; from you come a vigorous frame and wealth to the man who worships with sincerity and offers oblations

Special Topics

In the Mahāpitṛyajña ishti, when the Svishṭakṛt homa is performed, the oblation must be offered to the deity Agni Kavyavāhana. In that homa there are two Puronavākyā mantras. Of these, this Ṛk beginning त्वदग्ने काव्या (*tvadagne kāvyā*) is to be recited as the second Anuvākyā mantra. This is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra in the sūtra त्वदग्ने काव्या त्वन्मनीषाः स प्रत्नथा सहसा जायमानः (*tvadagne kāvyā tvanmanīṣāḥ sa pratnathā sahasā jāyamānaḥ*) (Ā. 2-19).

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वद्वा॒जी वा॑जम्भ॒रो विहा॑या अभिष्टि॒कृज्जा॑यते स॒त्यशु॑
ष्मः ।
त्वद्र॒यिर्दे॒वजू॑तो मयो॒भुस्त्वदा॒शुर्जू॑जु॒वाँ अ॑ग्ने॒ अर्वा॑ ॥
४ ॥

> *tvadvājī vājambharo vihāyā abhiṣṭikṛjjāyate satyaśuṣmaḥ |*
> *tvadrayirdevajūto mayobhustvadāśurjūjuvā~ agne arvā ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वत् । वाजी । वाजंभरः । विहायाः । अभिष्टिकृत् । जायते । सत्यशुष्मः ।
> त्वत् । रयिः । देवजूतः । मयःभुः । त्वत् । आशुः । जूजुवान् । अग्ने ।
> अर्वा ॥ ४ ॥

> *tvat | vājī | vājaṃbharaḥ | vihāyāḥ | abhiṣṭikṛt | jāyate | satyaśuṣmaḥ |*
> *tvat | rayiḥ | devajūtaḥ | mayaḥbhuḥ | tvat | āśuḥ | jūjuvān | agne |*
> *arvā ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने वाजी बलवान्वाजंभरो हविर्लक्षणान्नस्य वाहकः ॥ अग्नेर्वाजंभर
> इत्येषा वैदिकी संज्ञा । संज्ञायं भृत्यवृजीति वाजशब्दे कर्मण्युपपदे खच्.

> *he agne vājī balavānvājaṃbharo havirlakṣaṇānnasya vāhakaḥ ‖*
> *agnervājaṃbhara*
> *ityeṣā vaidikī saṃjñā | saṃjñāyaṃ bhṛtyavṛjīti vājaśabde*
> *karmaṇyupapade khac.*

> प्रत्ययः । अरुर्द्विषदजंतस्येति मुमागमः । चित इत्यंतोदात्तत्वं ॥ विहाया
> महानभिष्टि कृद्यज्ञकृत् अभ्येषणकृद्वा । सत्यशुष्कः सत्यबलः पुत्रस्त्वत्वत्तो जायते ।
> उत्पद्यते । देवजूतो देवैः प्रेरितो मयोभुः सुखप्रदः । मय इति
> सुखनामैतत् । रयिर्धनं त्वज्जायते । आशुः शीघ्रगामि । अप्रतिहतगमन इत्यर्थः।
> जूजुवान्वेगेन गच्छन्नर्वाश्वस्त्वद्भवतो जायते ॥

> *pratyayaḥ | arurdviṣadajaṃtasyeti mumāgamaḥ | cita ityaṃtodāttatvaṃ*
> *‖ vihāyā*
> *mahānabhiṣṭi kṛdyajñakṛt abhyeṣaṇakṛdvā | satyaśuṣkaḥ satyabalaḥ*
> *putrastvatvatto jāyate | utpadyate | devajūto devaiḥ prerito mayobhuḥ*
> *sukhapradaḥ | maya iti*
> *sukhanāmaitat | rayirdhanaṃ tvajjāyate | āśuḥ śīghragāmi |*
> *apratihatagamana ityarthaḥ|*
> *jūjuvānvegena gacchannarvāśvastvadbhavato jāyate ‖*

Summary

"Vājī" is the strong one; "vājambhara" is the bearer of the food that takes the form of the oblation. "Vājambhara" is a Vedic name of Agni. The word vāja, standing as the governed term in the sense of "action", takes the affix khac.

Vihāyāḥ means great. Abhiṣṭikṛt is the performer of the sacrifice, or one who brings about what is desired. Satyaśuṣma is one of true strength; a son is born from you. Devajūta is impelled by the gods; mayobhu is the giver of happiness (मय (*maya*) is a name for happiness). Rayi is wealth; it is born from you. Āśu is swift-going, i.e. of unobstructed motion. Jūjuvān, the horse going with speed, is born from you.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- वाजी (*vājī*)—the strong
- वाजंभरः (*vājaṃbharaḥ*)—the bearer of food in the form of oblation
- विहायाः (*vihāyāḥ*)—the possessor of great qualities
- अभिष्टिकृत् (*abhiṣṭikṛt*)—the performer of the sacrifice
- सत्यशुष्कः (*satyaśuṣkaḥ*)—the son possessing strength of truth
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—from you
- जायते (*jāyate*)—is born
- देवजूतः (*devajūtaḥ*)—that accepted by the gods
- मयोभुः (*mayobhuḥ*)—that which brings happiness
- रयिः (*rayiḥ*)—wealth
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—from you alone it arises
- आशुः (*āśuḥ*)—swift-going
- जूजुवान् (*jūjuvān*)—of unhindered movement
- अर्वा (*arvā*)—the horse
- त्वत् (*tvat*)—from you alone it arises

Gist

O Agni, a son who is strong, bears food in the form of oblation, has great qualities, performs sacrifice and has strength of truth is born from you alone. Wealth accepted by the gods and bringing happiness arises from you alone. A horse that is swift and of unhindered movement also arises from you alone.

English translation

From you, who are vigorous, the conveyer of oblations, the vast, the granter of what is desired, is born (a son) of real strength ; from you comes wealth approved of by the gods, the source of happiness ; from you, Agni, (is obtained) a swift unarrested horse.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वाम॑ग्ने प्रथ॒मं दे॑व॒यन्तो॑ दे॒वं मर्ता॑ अमृत म॒न्द्रजि॑ह्वम् ।
द्वे॒षो॒युत॒मा विं॑वासन्ति धी॒भिर्दमूं॑नसं गृ॒हप॑ति॒ममूं॑रम् ॥ ५ ॥

> *tvāmagne prathamaṃ devayanto devaṃ martā amṛta mandrajihvam |*
> *dveṣoyutamā vivāsanti dhībhirdamūnasaṃ gṛhapatimamūram ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वां । अग्ने । प्रथमं । देवयंतः । देवं । वंर्ताः । अमृत । मंद्रजिह्वं ।
> द्वेषयुतं । आ । विवासंति । धीभिः । दमूनसं । गृहपतिं । अमूरं ॥ ५ ॥

> *tvāṃ | agne | prathamaṃ | devayaṃtaḥ | devaṃ | vaṃrtāḥ | amṛta | maṃdrajihvaṃ |*
> *dveṣayutaṃ | ā | vivāsaṃti | dhībhiḥ | damūnasaṃ | gṛhapatiṃ | amūraṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अमृत अमरणशीलाग्ने देवयंतो देवानिच्छंतो मर्ता मनुष्या यजमानास्तां धीभिः स्तुतिभिः कर्मभिर्वा आ विवासंति । समंतात्परिचरंति। कीदृशं त्वां । प्रथमं देवानामाद्यं देवं द्योतमानं मंद्रजिह्वं । देवानां मादयित्रि जिह्वा यस्य तं । द्वेषोयुतं द्वेषसां पापानां पृथक्कर्तारं दमूनसं रक्षसां दमनकरेण मनसोपेतं । दमूनःशब्दस्य कथमयमर्थ इति दमूना

> दममना वा दानमना वा दांतमना वापि वा दम इति गृहनाम तन्नानाः स्यादिति
> यास्केनोक्तत्वादिति ॥ दमु उपशमने । दमेरूनसिरित्याणादिक ऊनसिप्रत्ययः ॥
> गृहपतिं गृहाणां पालयितारममूरममूढं । प्रगल्भमित्यर्थः ॥

> *he amṛta amaraṇaśīlāgne devayaṃto devānicchaṃto martā manuṣyā*
> *yajamānāstāṃ dhībhiḥ stutibhiḥ karmabhirvā ā vivāsaṃti |*
> *samaṃtātparicaraṃti| kīdṛśaṃ*
> *tvāṃ | prathamaṃ devānāmādyaṃ devaṃ dyotamānaṃ maṃdrajihvaṃ*
> *| devānāṃ mādayitri jihvā yasya taṃ | dveṣoyutaṃ dveṣasāṃ pāpānāṃ*
> *pṛthakkartāraṃ damūnasaṃ*
> *rakṣasāṃ damanakareṇa manasopetaṃ | damūnaḥśabdasya*
> *kathamayamartha iti damūnā*
> *damamanā vā dānamanā vā dāṃtamanā vāpi vā dama iti gṛhanāma*
> *tannanāḥ syāditi*
> *yāskenoktatvāditi ‖ damu upaśamane | damerūnasirityāṇādika*
> *ūnasipratyayaḥ ‖*
> *gṛhapatiṃ gṛhāṇāṃ pālayitāramamūramamūḍhaṃ |*
> *pragalbhamityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

O immortal Agni, mortals, the sacrificers who desire the gods, serve you all around with praises or rites. You are the first of the gods, shining (deva), mandrajihva, one whose tongue gladdens the gods; dveṣoyuta, the separator of hateful sins; damūnas, one whose mind is subduer of the rākṣasas. Why this meaning of damūnas? Because Yāska says: "damūnas is of subdued mind, or of giving mind, or of restrained mind; or else dama is a name for house, so one whose mind is on the house." The affix ūnasi is Uṇādi. Gṛhapati is the protector of houses; amūra is not bewildered, i.e. bold.

Word-to-word meaning

- अमृत (*amṛta*)—deathless
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- देवयंतः (*devayaṃtaḥ*)—the god-devoted
- मर्ताः (*martāḥ*)—mortal sacrificers
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—chief among the gods
- देवं (*devaṃ*)—the shining one

- मंद्रजिह्वं (*maṃdrajihvaṃ*)—one whose tongue satisfies (the gods)
- द्वेषोयुतं (*dveṣoyutaṃ*)—the separator of sinners
- दमूनसं (*damūnasaṃ*)—the destroyer of rākṣasas
- गृहपतिं (*gṛhapatiṃ*)—the protector of houses
- अमूरं (*amūraṃ*)—the wise
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- धीभिः (*dhībhiḥ*)—by rites accompanied by praise
- आ विवासंति (*ā vivāsaṃti*)—serve all around

Gist

O deathless Agni, the god-devoted mortal sacrificers serve you all around with rites accompanied by praise—you who are chief among the gods, shining, with a tongue that satisfies the gods, separator of sinners, destroyer of rākṣasas, protector of houses, wise.

English translation

Immortal Agni, devout mortals worship with holy rites you the first deity (of the gods), whose tongue exhilarates (them), the dissipator of sin, the humiliator (of the demons), the lord of the mansion, the unperplexed.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒रे अ॒स्मदम॑तिमा॒रे अंह॑ आ॒रे विश्वां॑ दु॒र्मतिं यन्नि॒पासि॑ ।
दो॒षा शि॒वः स॑हसः सूनो अग्ने॒ यं दे॒व आ चि॒त्सच॑से स्व॒स्ति ॥ ६ ॥

> *āre asmadamatimāre aṃha āre viśvāṃ durmatiṃ yannipāsi |*
> *doṣā śivaḥ sahasaḥ sūno agne yaṃ deva ā citsacase svasti ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आरे । अस्मत् । अमतिं । आरे । अंहः । आरे । विश्वां । दुःमतिं । यत् । निपासि ।
> दोषा । शिवः । सहसः । सूनोऽइति । अग्ने । यं । देवः । आ । चित् । सचसे । स्वस्ति ॥

> *āre | asmat | amatiṃ | āre | aṃhaḥ | āre | viśvāṃ | duḥmatiṃ | yat | nipāsi |*
> *doṣā | śivaḥ | sahasaḥ | sūno 'iti | agne | yaṃ | devaḥ | ā | cit | sacase | svasti ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> स्वस्त्ययन्यामारे अस्मदिति स्वस्तिमतोऽग्नेयाज्या । सूत्रितं च । आरे
> अस्मदमतिमारे अंहः । आ. २-८० । इति ॥
> हे सहसः सूनो बलस्य पुत्र । मध्यमानोऽग्निर्मथनकारिणां हि बलेन
> जायत इत्यग्नेर्बलपुत्रत्वं । हे अग्ने दोषा रात्रौ शिवः शिवकरो देवो द्योतमानस्त्वं यं यानस्मान्
> स्वस्त्रविनाशाय आ सचसे । परितः सेवसे। चिदिति पूरणः।
> यद्यस्मात्कारणान्निपासि । यजमानान्वितरां पालयसि । तेभ्योऽस्मदस्मत्तोऽमतिं
> पापरूपामशनेच्छामारे दूरे कुरु । अशनाया वै पाप्मामतिः । ऐ. ब्रा. २-२ ।
> इति ब्राह्मणं । आरे दूरेऽस्मत्तोऽंहः पापं कुरु । आरे इति दूरनामैतत् ।
> अस्मत्त आरे दूरे दुर्मतिं दुर्मनस्त्वं कुरु ॥

> *svastyayanyāmāre asmaditi svastimato 'gneyājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | āre*
> *asmadamatimāre aṃhaḥ | ā. 2-80 | iti ‖*
> *he sahasaḥ sūno balasya putra | madhyamāno 'gnirmathanakāriṇāṃ hi balena*
> *jāyata ityagnerbalaputratvaṃ | he agne doṣā rātrau śivaḥ śivakaro devo dyotamānastvaṃ yaṃ yānasmān svastravināśāya ā sacase | paritaḥ sevase| cdiditi pūraṇaḥ|*
> *yadyasmātkāraṇānnipāsi | yajamānānvitarāṃ pālayasi | tebhyo 'smadasmatto 'matiṃ*
> *pāparūpāmaśanecchāmāre dūre kuru | aśanāyā vai pāpmāmatiḥ | ai. brā. 2-2 |*
> *iti brāhmaṇaṃ | āre dūre 'smatto 'ṃhaḥ pāpaṃ kuru | āre iti dūranāmaitat |*
> *asmatta āre dūre durmatiṃ durmanastvaṃ kuru ‖*

Summary

This is the yājyā of Agni Svastimat in the Svastyayanī ishti; it is prescribed in the sūtra आरे अस्मदमतिमारे अंहः (*āre asmadamatimāre aṃhaḥ*) (Ā. 2-80). "O son of strength (sahas)": fire, when churned, is born from the strength of the churners, hence Agni is called the son of strength. O Agni, auspicious by night, shining, you attend all around us for our well-being (चित् (*cit*) is expletive); since you protect the sacrificers, remove far from us amati, i.e. the desire to eat, which is sin. Quoted: अशनाया वै पाप्मामतिः (*aśanāyā vai pāpmāmatiḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 2-2), thus the Brāhmaṇa. Make sin (aṃhas) far from us. आरे (*āre*) is a name for "far". Make ill-mindedness far from us.

Word-to-word meaning

- सहसः सूनो (*sahasaḥ sūno*)—O son of strength
- अग्ने (*agne*)—Agni
- दोषा (*doṣā*)—in the nights
- शिवः (*śivaḥ*)—auspicious
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—you, the shining
- यत् (*yat*)—with which gracious intention
- स्वस्ति (*svasti*)—for imperishable welfare
- यं (*yaṃ*)—us, the sacrificers whom
- आ सचसे चित् (*ā sacase cit*)—you attend all around
- निपासि (*nipāsi*)—you protect us the sacrificers
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—from us
- अमतिं (*amatiṃ*)—evil-mindedness
- आरे (*āre*)—keep far
- अंहः (*aṃhaḥ*)—sin
- आरे (*āre*)—make far
- विश्वा (*viśvā*)—all
- दुर्मतिं (*durmatiṃ*)—even sinful thought
- आरे (*āre*)—make far from us

Gist

O Agni, son of strength, you who are auspicious by night and shining, with whatever gracious intention you attend all around us the sacrificers for imperishable welfare, make evil-mindedness, the sin caused by poverty, and all sinful thought remain far from those same sacrificers, us.

English translation

Agni, son of strength, since you protect (your worshippers), far (remove) from us all iniquity ; far (remove from us) sin; far (from us) all evil thoughts; for prosperous is he of whom you, who are radiant by night, promote the well-being.

Special Topics

In the ishti called Svastyayanī, this Ṛk आरे अस्मत् (*āre asmat*) is to be recited as the yājyā mantra when the oblation is offered to Agni Svastimat. This is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra in the sūtra आरे अस्मदमतिमारे अंहः (*āre asmadamatimāre aṃhaḥ*) (Ā. 2-10). The bhāṣyakāra quotes the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa sentence अशनाया वै पाप्मामतिः (*aśanāyā vai pāpmāmatiḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 2-2). This matter was explained clearly when we expounded Ṛk 3-8-2 (Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 15, pp. 82-83).[?437]

Sūkta 12 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> यस्त्वामग्न इति षड्टृचं द्वितीयं सूक्तं । वामदेव ऋषिः । त्रैष्टुभं
> छंदः । अग्निर्देवता । यस्त्वामित्यनुक्रांतं ॥ प्रातरनुवाकाश्विनशस्त्रयोः पूर्वसूक्तेन सहोक्तो विनियोगः ॥

> *yastvāmagna iti ṣaḍṛcaṃ dvitīyaṃ sūktaṃ | vāmadeva ṛṣiḥ | traiṣṭubhaṃ*
> *chaṃdaḥ | agnirdevatā | yastvāmityanukrāṃtaṃ ‖*
> *prātaranuvākāśvinaśastrayoḥ pūrvasūktena sahokto viniyogaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The second sūkta, of six Ṛks, beginning यस्त्वामग्न (*yastvāmagna*). The seer is Vāmadeva, the metre Triṣṭubh, the deity Agni; the Anukramaṇī says यस्त्वां (*yastvāṃ*). Its application, together with the preceding sūkta, is stated for the Prātaranuvāka and the Āśvina śastra.

> अनुवादवु—यस्त्वामग्ने ऎंब ई सूक्तवु ऎरडनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि ऎरडनॆय सूक्तवु.
> इदरल्लि आरु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋषियु ; अग्नियु देवतॆयु ; त्रिष्टुप्
> छंदस्सु. अनुक्रमणिकॆयल्लि—यस्त्वां ऎंदु मॊदलागि हेळिरुवुदु. प्रातरनुवाक मत्तु
> आश्विनशस्त्रमंत्रपठनक्कागि हिंदिन सूक्तदॊडनॆ ई सूक्तद विनियोगवू इरुवुदु.
> सूक्त–१२
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—२ ॥ सूक्त—१२
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—१२ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्यॆ—६
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः
> देवता—अग्निः
> छंदः—त्रिष्टुप् ॥

> *anuvādavu—yastvāmagne èṃba ī sūktavu èraḍanèya anuvākadalli èraḍanèya sūktavu.*
> *idaralli āru ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu ; agniyu devatèyu ; triṣṭup*
> *chaṃdassu. anukramaṇikèyalli—yastvāṃ èṃdu mòdalāgi heḷiruvudu.*

> *prātaranuvāka mattu*
> *āśvinaśastramaṃtrapaṭhanakkāgi hiṃdina sūktadòḍanè ī sūktada*
> *viniyogavū iruvudu.*
> *sūkta-12*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—2 ‖ sūkta—12*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—12 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—6*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ*
> *devatā—agniḥ*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭup ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यस्त्वामं॑ग्न इ॒नधं॑ते य॒तस्रु॒क्त्रिस्ते॒ अन्नं॑ कृ॒णव॒त्सस्मि॒न्न
हं॑न् ।
स सु द्यु॒म्नैर॒भ्यं॑स्तु प्र॒सक्ष॒त्तव॒ क्रत्वां॑ जातवेदश्चिकि॒
त्वान् ॥ १ ॥

> *yastvāmagna inadhate yatasruktriste annaṃ kṛṇavatsasminnahan |*
> *sa su dyumnairabhyastu prasakṣattava kratvā jātavedaścikitvān ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । त्वां । अग्ने । इनधते । यत्स्रुक् । त्रिः । ते । अन्नं । कृणवत् । सस्मिन् ।
> अहन् ।
> सः । सु । द्युम्नैः । अभि । अस्तु । प्रसक्षत् । तव । क्रत्वा । जातवेदः । चिकित्वान् ॥१॥

> *yaḥ | tvāṃ | agne | inadhate | yatsruk | triḥ | te | annaṃ | kṛṇavat |*
> *sasmin |*
> *ahan |*
> *saḥ | su | dyumnaiḥ | abhi | astu | prasakṣat | tava | kratvā |*
> *jātavedaḥ | cikitvān ‖1‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यतस्रुक् स्रुचा संबद्धो यो यजमानस्त्वामिनधते । दीप्तियुक्तं कुर्यात् । यः सस्मिन्नहन् सर्वस्मिन्नहनि ते तुभ्यं त्रिस्तिवारं सवनत्रयेऽन्नं हविर्लक्षणमन्नं कृणवत् । कुर्यात् । हे जातवेदो जातानां वेदितरग्ने

> *he agne yatasruk srucā saṃbaddho yo yajamānastvāminadhate | dīptiyuktaṃ kuryāt | yaḥ sasminnahan sarvasminnahani te tubhyaṃ tristivāraṃ savanatraye 'nnaṃ havirlakṣaṇamannaṃ kṛṇavat | kuryāt | he jātavedo jātānāṃ veditaragne*

> तव तोषकेण क्रत्वेंधनादिहेतुना कर्मणा प्रसक्षत् प्रसहमानं त्वदीयं तेजश्चिकित्वान् जानन् स यजमानो द्युम्नैर्धनैर्यशोभिर्वा सु अत्यंतमभ्यस्तु ।
> शत्रूनभिभवतु ॥

> *tava toṣakeṇa kratveṃdhanādihetunā karmaṇā prasakṣat prasahamānaṃ tvadīyaṃ tejaścikitvān jānan sa yajamāno dyumnairdhanairyaśobhirvā su atyaṃtamabhyastu |*
> *śatrūnabhibhavatu ||*

Summary

O Agni, the sacrificer who, ladle in hand, kindles you, makes you blazing; who on every day offers you the oblation-food three times, at the three libations; O Jātavedas, knower of all that is born—

Sāyaṇa completes his gloss. Through क्रत्वा (*kratvā*) he means the act that pleases Agni, the act that is the cause of kindling and the like. The worshipper who knows प्रसक्षत् (*prasakṣat*), Agni's overpowering splendour, is to prevail greatly (सु अत्यंतं (*su atyaṃtaṃ*)) with wealth or with fame. In other words, he is to overcome his enemies.

Word-to-word meaning

- जातवेदः (*jātavedaḥ*)—O Agni of born (perfect) wisdom
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यतस्रुक् (*yatasruk*)—holding up the ladle
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the sacrificer who
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- इनधते (*inadhate*)—makes you radiant
- सस्मिन्नहन् (*sasminnahan*)—on all days

- ते (*te*)—addressed to you
- त्रिः (*triḥ*)—at the three times of the pressings
- अन्नं (*annaṃ*)—food in the form of the oblation
- कृणवत् (*kṛṇavat*)—offers
- सः (*saḥ*)—that sacrificer
- तव (*tava*)—your
- क्रत्वा (*kratvā*)—by acts that please you
- प्रसक्षत् (*prasakṣat*)—your unobstructed splendour
- चिकित्वान् (*cikitvān*)—having known
- द्युम्नैः (*dyumnaiḥ*)—with riches and with fame as well
- सु (*su*)—exceedingly
- अभ्यस्तु (*abhyastu*)—may he defeat his enemies

Gist

O Agni, of born wisdom: the sacrificer who, holding up the ladle, makes you shine, and who on all days, addressing you, offers food in the form of the oblation at the three times of the pressings — let that sacrificer, knowing your unobstructed splendour through acts that please you, overcome his enemies exceedingly, with riches and with fame.

English translation

May he who with uplifted ladle kindles you, and thrice every day presents to you the (sacrificial) food, knowing your glory, Jatavedas, to be invigorated by the act, surpass (all others) in riches.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इ॒ध्मं यस्ते॑ ज॒भर॑च्छश्रमा॒णो म॒हो अ॑ग्ने॒ अनी॑क॒मा स॑प॒र्यन् ।
स इ॑धा॒नः प्रति॑ दो॒षामु॒षासं॒ पुष्य॑न्र॒यिं स॑चते॒ घ्नन्न॒मित्रा॑न् ॥ २ ॥

> *idhmaṃ yaste jabharacchaśramāṇo maho agne anīkamā saparyan |*
> *sa idhānaḥ prati doṣāmuṣāsaṃ puṣyanrayiṃ sacate ghnannamitrān ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इध्मं । यः । ते । जभरत् । शश्रमाणः । महः । अग्ने । अनेकं । आ । सपर्यन् ।
> सः । इधानः । प्रति । दोषां । उषसं । पुष्यन् । रयिं । सचते । घ्नन् । अमित्रान्॥

> *idhmaṃ | yaḥ | te | jabharat | śaśramāṇaḥ | mahaḥ | agne | anekaṃ |*
> *ā | saparyan |*
> *saḥ | idhānaḥ | prati | doṣāṃ | uṣasaṃ | puṣyan | rayiṃ | sacate |*
> *ghnan | amitrān‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने यो यजमानस्ते तुभ्यमिध्वं होमसाधनं समिज्ञातं जभरत् ।
> आहरेत् ॥ हृञ् हरणे । लिजर्थे लेट् । तस्य तिप इतश्च लोप इतीकारलोपः ।
> बहुलं छंदसीति शपः श्लुः । द्विर्वचनादिकार्यं । लेटोऽडाटावित्यडागमः । हृग्रहोर्भ इति भत्वं
> ॥ शश्रमाण इध्माद्याहरणे श्राम्यन्महो महतस्तवानीकं । आकारश्चार्थे । तेजश्च सपर्यन्परिचरन्
> यो यजमानो दोषां प्रति रात्रिं लक्ष्मीकृत्योषसं प्रत्युषःकालं च लक्ष्मीकृत्य ।
> कालद्वयेऽपीत्यर्थः । इधान इंधानस्त्वां
> दीप्तियुक्तं करोति पुष्यन् प्रजाभिः पशुभिश्च पुष्टः सन् स यजमानोऽमित्रान्
> शत्रून् घ्नस्सिंसन्नयिं धनं सचते । सेवते । सर्वदा पश्वादिधनसमृद्धो भवतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *he agne yo yajamānaste tubhyamidhvaṃ homasādhanaṃ samijñātaṃ*
> *jabharat |*
> *āharet ‖ hṛñ haraṇe | lijarthe leṭ | tasya tipa itaśca lopa itīkāralopaḥ |*
> *bahulaṃ chaṃdasīti śapaḥ śluḥ | dvirvacanādikāryaṃ | leṭo*
> *'ḍāṭāvityaḍāgamaḥ | hṛgrahorbha iti bhatvaṃ ‖ śaśramāṇa*
> *idhmādyāharaṇe śrāmyanmaho mahatastavānīkaṃ | ākāraścārthe |*
> *tejaśca saparyanparicaran yo yajamāno doṣāṃ prati rātriṃ*
> *lakṣmīkṛtyoṣasaṃ pratyuṣaḥkālaṃ ca lakṣmīkṛtya | kāladvaye*
> *'pītyarthaḥ | idhāna iṃdhānastvāṃ*
> *dīptiyuktaṃ karoti puṣyan prajābhiḥ paśubhiśca puṣṭaḥ san sa yajamāno*
> *'mitrān*
> *śatrūn ghnassiṃsanrayiṃ dhanaṃ sacate | sevate | sarvadā*
> *paśvādidhanasamṛddho bhavatītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Agni, the sacrificer who brings you इध्मं (*idhmaṃ*), the fuel, that is, the means of the oblation, known as the samidh. जभरत् (*jabharat*) means "would bring"; the root is हृञ् (*hṛñ*) in the sense of carrying. शश्रमाणः (*śaśramāṇaḥ*) is one who toils in fetching the fuel and the rest. महः (*mahaḥ*) is "of the great you", your *anīkaṃ*, and आ (*ā*) has the sense of "and"; the sacrificer serves (सपर्यन् (*saparyan*)) your splendour as well. Taking the night (दोषां प्रति (*doṣāṃ prati*)) and the dawn-time (उषसं (*uṣasaṃ*)) as his marks, that is, at both times, he kindles you (इधानः (*idhānaḥ*)) and makes you blazing. Nourished (पुष्यन् (*puṣyan*)) with offspring and cattle, that sacrificer, wishing to destroy his enemies, obtains wealth (रयिं सचते (*rayiṃ sacate*)); सचते (*sacate*) means "enjoys". The sense is that he is always rich in cattle and other wealth.?438

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the sacrificer who
- ते (*te*)—addressed to you
- इध्मं (*idhmaṃ*)—the samidh sticks, parts of the oblation
- जभरत् (*jabharat*)—lays on
- शश्रमाणः (*śaśramāṇaḥ*)—taking toil at the time of fetching the fuel
- महः (*mahaḥ*)—of you, of great nature
- आ अनेकं (*ā anekaṃ*)—the splendour
- सपर्यन् (*saparyan*)—worshipping
- दोषां प्रति (*doṣāṃ prati*)—at night
- उषसं (*uṣasaṃ*)—at dawn
- इधानः (*idhānaḥ*)—who makes you blaze
- सः (*saḥ*)—that sacrificer
- पुष्यन् (*puṣyan*)—attaining increase of offspring
- अमित्रान् (*amitrān*)—enemies
- घ्नन् (*ghnan*)—destroying
- रयिं (*rayiṃ*)—wealth of cattle and the like
- सचते (*sacate*)—enjoys

Gist

O Agni, the sacrificer who, addressing you, brings the samidh sticks that are parts of the oblation, taking toil at the time of fetching the fuel, worships your splendour of great nature, and makes you blaze at night and at dawn — that sacrificer attains increase of offspring, destroys his enemies, and obtains wealth of cattle and the like.

English translation

He who, labouring diligently, brings you fuel, honouring Agni, your great glory ; he who kindles you in the evening and at dawn ; he, prosperous and destroying his enemies, acquires riches.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒ग्निरी॑शे बृह॒तः क्ष॒त्रिय॑स्या॒ग्निर्वाज॑स्य पर॒मस्य॑ रा॒यः
।
दधा॑ति॒ रत्नं᳚ विध॒ते यवि॑ष्ठो॒ व्या॑नु॒षङ्मर्त्या॑य स्व॒धा
वा॑न् ॥ ३ ॥

> *agnirīśe bṛhataḥ kṣatriyasyāgnirvājasya paramasya rāyaḥ |*
> *dadhāti ratnaṃ vidhate yaviṣṭho vyānuṣaṅmartyāya svadhāvān ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अग्निः । ईशे । बृहतः । क्षत्रियस्य । अग्निः । वाजस्य । परमस्य । रायः ।
> दधाति । रत्नं । विधते । यविष्ठः । वि । आनुषक् । मर्त्याय । स्वधाऽवान् ॥ ३ ॥

> *agniḥ | īśe | bṛhataḥ | kṣatriyasya | agniḥ | vājasya | paramasya | rāyaḥ |*
> *dadhāti | ratnaṃ | vidhate | yaviṣṭhaḥ | vi | ānuṣak | martyāya | svadhā 'vān ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उखासंभरणीयेष्टावग्नेः क्षत्रभृतोऽनुवाक्या । तथा च सूत्रितं । अग्निरीशे बृहतः क्षत्रियस्यार्चामि ते सुमतिं घोषर्वाक् । आ. ४–१ । इति ॥
> अग्निर्बृहतो महतः क्षत्रियस्य बलस्येशे । ईश्वरो भवति ॥ वर्तमानार्थे
> लिट् ॥ किंच अग्निः परमस्योत्कृष्टस्य वाजस्यान्नस्य रायः पश्वादेर्धनस्य चेशे ।
> यविष्ठो युवतमः स्वधावानन्नवान् तेजस्वी वाग्निर्विधते । परिचरते । विधतिः
> परिचरणकर्मति यास्कः । मर्त्याय मनुष्याय यजमानाय रत्नं रमणीयं
> धनमानुषक् अनुषक्तं वि दधाति । करोति ॥

> *ukhāsaṃbharaṇīyeṣṭāvagneḥ kṣatrabhṛto 'nuvākyā | tathā ca sūtritaṃ |*
> *agnirīśe bṛhataḥ kṣatriyasyārcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣarvāk | ā. 4-1 | iti ‖*
> *agnirbṛhato mahataḥ kṣatriyasya balasyeśe | īśvaro bhavati ‖ vartamānārthe*
> *liṭ ‖ kiṃca agniḥ paramasyotkṛṣṭasya vājasyānnasya rāyaḥ paśvāderdhanasya ceśe |*
> *yaviṣṭo yuvatamaḥ svadhāvānannavān tejasvī vāgnirvidhate | paricarate | vidhatiḥ*
> *paricaraṇakarmati yāskaḥ | martyāya manuṣyāya yajamānāya ratnaṃ ramaṇīyaṃ*
> *dhanamānuṣak anuṣaktaṃ vi dadhāti | karoti ‖*

Summary

The verse is the anuvākyā for Agni Kṣatrabhṛt in the Ukhāsaṃbharaṇīya offering. So it is laid down in the sūtra: अग्निरीशे बृहतः क्षत्रियस्यार्चामि ते सुमतिं घोषर्वाक् (*agnirīśe bṛhataḥ kṣatriyasyārcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣarvāk*) (Ā. 4-1). Agni is lord (ईशे (*īśe*), "is master"; a perfect in the sense of the present) of great (बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)) strength (क्षत्रियस्य (*kṣatriyasya*)). Further, Agni is lord of the highest food (वाजस्य (*vājasya*)) and of wealth (रायः (*rāyaḥ*)) such as cattle. यविष्ठो (*yaviṣṭo*) is the youngest; स्वधावान् (*svadhāvān*) is possessed of food, or full of splendour. Agni विधते (*vidhate*), serves; Yāska says विधतिः (*vidhatiḥ*) is a word for the act of service. To the mortal, the man, the sacrificer, he वि दधाति (*vi dadhāti*), provides precious (रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*), delightful) wealth, आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*), in continuous succession.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—of very great
- क्षत्रियस्य (*kṣatriyasya*)—strength
- ईशे (*īśe*)—is the lord
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—that same great Agni
- परमस्य (*paramasya*)—of the most excellent
- वाजस्य (*vājasya*)—food
- रायः (*rāyaḥ*)—and of wealth of cattle and the like, is the lord
- यविष्ठः (*yaviṣṭhaḥ*)—the very young
- स्वधावान् (*svadhāvān*)—and splendid Agni
- विधते (*vidhate*)—serves (the sacrificer)
- मर्त्याय (*martyāya*)—to the human sacrificer
- रत्नं (*ratnaṃ*)—delightful wealth
- आनुषक् (*ānuṣak*)—according to each man's act
- वि दधाति (*vi dadhāti*)—provides

Gist

Agni is lord of great power. That same great Agni is lord of the most excellent food and of wealth of cattle and the like. Agni, very young and splendid, serves the sacrificer. To the human sacrificer he provides delightful wealth according to each man's act.

English translation

Agni is the possessor of great strength, of excellent food, of riches, the youngest (of the gods) : abounding in sustenance, he gives to the mortal who worships him precious (wealth) according to (his devotion)

Special Topics

In the Ukhāsaṃbharaṇa offering, when a Kṣatriya makes the oblation addressed to Agni, this Ṛk, अग्निरीशे बृहतः (*agnirīśe bṛhataḥ*), is to be recited as the puronuvākyā mantra; this is explained by the

sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta-sūtra अग्निशरीरे बृहतः क्षत्रियस्यार्चामि ते सुमतिं घोष्यर्वाक् (*agniśarīre bṛhataḥ kṣatriyasyārcāmi te sumatiṃ ghoṣyarvāk*) (Ā. 4-1).?439

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यच्चि॒द्धि ते॑ पुरुष॒त्रा य॑वि॒ष्ठाचि॑त्तिभिश्चकृ॒मा कच्चि॒दाग॑ः ।
कृ॒धी ष्व१॒॑स्माँ अदि॑ते॒रना॑गा॒न्व्येनां॑सि शिश्रथो॒ विष्वं॑गग्ने ॥ ४ ॥

> *yacciddhi te puruṣatrā yaviṣṭhācittibhiścakṛmā kaccidāgaḥ |*
> *kṛdhī ṣvasmā~ aditeranāgānvyenāṃsi śiśratho viṣvagagne ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यत् । चित् । हि । ते । पुरुषत्रा । यविष्ठ । अचित्तिभिः । चक्रम । कत् । चित् । आगः।
> कृधि । सु । अस्मान् । आदितेः । अनागान् । वि । एनांसि । शिश्रथः । विस्वक् । अग्ने ॥ ४ ॥

> *yat | cit | hi | te | puruṣatrā | yaviṣṭha | acittibhiḥ | cakrama | kat | cit | āgaḥ|*
> *kṛdhi | su | asmān | āditeḥ | anāgān | vi | enāṃsi | śiśrathaḥ | visvak | agne ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे यविष्ठ युवतमाग्ने यच्चिद्धि यद्यपि खलु ते त्वदीयेषु पुरुषत्रा
> परिचारकेषु पुरुषेष्वचित्तिभिरज्ञानैः कच्चिदागः किंचिदपि पापं वयं चक्रम तथापि
> हे अग्ने अस्मानदितेर्भूमेरनागाननागसः पापरहितान् सु अत्यंतं कृधि । कुरु ।
> हे अग्ने विश्वक् सर्वतो विद्यमानानेनांस्यस्माभिः कृतानि पापानि वि शिश्रथः ।
> विश्लथय । शिथिली कुरु ॥

> *he yaviṣṭha yuvatamāgne yacciddhi yadyapi khalu te tvadīyeṣu puruṣatrā paricārakeṣu puruṣeṣvacittibhirajñānaiḥ kaccidāgaḥ kiṃcidapi pāpaṃ vayaṃ cakrama tathāpi*
> *he agne asmānaditerbhūmeranāgānanāgasaḥ pāparahitān su atyaṃtaṃ kṛdhi | kuru |*
> *he agne viśvak sarvato vidyamānānenāṃsyasmābhiḥ kṛtāni pāpāni vi śiśrathaḥ |*
> *viślathaya | śithilī kuru ||*

Summary

O youngest Agni, even if we have committed some offence, through ignorances (अचित्तिभिः (*acittibhiḥ*)), against the men who are your servants (पुरुषत्रा (*puruṣatrā*)), nevertheless make us अनागान् (*anāgān*), free of fault and sin, of Aditi, the earth; make us so exceedingly (सु (*su*)). And loosen, slacken, weaken (वि शिश्रथः (*vi śiśrathaḥ*)) the offences (एनांसि (*enāṃsi*)), the sins we have committed, which are present everywhere (विश्वक् (*viśvak*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- यविष्ठ (*yaviṣṭha*)—O very young
- अग्ने (*agne*)—Agni
- यच्चिद्धि (*yacciddhi*)—for some reason (by accident)
- ते (*te*)—in your matter
- पुरुषत्रा (*puruṣatrā*)—common to man
- अचित्तिभिः (*acittibhiḥ*)—through ignorances
- कच्चिदागः (*kaccidāgaḥ*)—any sin
- चक्रम (*cakrama*)—if we have done
- अस्मान् (*asmān*)—us
- अदितेः (*aditeḥ*)—earthly
- अनागान् (*anāgān*)—sinless
- सु (*su*)—exceedingly
- कृधि (*kṛdhi*)—make
- विष्वक् (*viṣvak*)—all-pervading
- एनांसि (*enāṃsi*)—sins
- वि शिश्रथः (*vi śiśrathaḥ*)—destroy

Gist

O very young Agni, if in your matter we have by accident, through ignorances natural to man, committed any sin, make us free of that earthly sin. Destroy those all-pervading sins of ours.

English translation

If, youngest (of the gods), with the inconsiderateness common to men, we have ever committed any offence against you, make us free from the defects of earth ; efface entirely, Agni, our offences.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

म॒हश्चि॑दग्न॒ एन॑सो अ॒भीक॑ ऊ॒र्वाद्दे॒वाना॑मु॒त मर्त्या॑नाम् ।
मा ते॒ सखा॑य॒ः सद॒मिद्रि॑षाम॒ यच्छा॑ तो॒काय॒ तन॑याय॒ शं योः ॥ ५ ॥

> *mahaścidagna enaso abhīka ūrvāddevānāmuta martyānām |*
> *mā te sakhāyaḥ sadamidriṣāma yacchā tokāya tanayāya śaṃ yoḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> महः । चित् । अग्ने । एनसः । अभीके । ऊर्वात् । देवानां । उत । मर्त्यानां ।
> मा । ते । सखायः । सदं । इत् । रिषाम । यच्छ । तोकाय । तनयाय । शं ।
> योः ॥ ५ ॥

> *mahaḥ | cit | agne | enasaḥ | abhīke | ūrvāt | devānāṃ | uta | martyānāṃ |*
> *mā | te | sakhāyaḥ | sadaṃ | it | riṣāma | yaccha | tokāya | tanayāya | śaṃ |*
> *yoḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अग्ने देवानामिंद्रादीनामुत अपि च मर्त्यानां मनुष्याणामभिकेऽंतिके । अभीक
> इत्यंतिकनामैतत् । अस्माभिर्यत्पापं कृतं महश्चिन्महतोऽपूर्वाद्विस्त्रतादस्मादेनसः पापात्ते
> त्वदीयाः सखायो मित्रभूताः स्तोतारो वयं
> सदमित्सर्वदैव मा रिषाम । मा हिंसिता भूम । हे अग्ने त्वं तोकाय पुत्राय
> तनयाय पौत्राय शं पापरूपोपद्रवाणां शांतिं योः सुकृतोत्पादितं सुखं
> च यच्छ । देहि ॥
> Vol 17.

> *he agne devānāmimṃdrādīnāmuta api ca martyānāṃ manuṣyāṇāmabhike 'ṃtike | abhīka ityaṃtikanāmaitat | asmābhiryatpāpaṃ kṛtaṃ mahaścinmahato 'pūrvādvistratādasmādenasaḥ pāpātte tvadīyāḥ sakhāyo mitrabhūtāḥ stotāro vayaṃ*
> *sadamitsarvadaiva mā riṣāma | mā hiṃsitā bhūma | he agne tvaṃ tokāya putrāya*
> *tanayāya pautrāya śaṃ pāparūpopadravāṇāṃ śāṃtiṃ yoḥ sukṛtotpāditaṃ sukhaṃ*
> *ca yaccha | dehi ‖*
> *Vol 17.*

Summary

O Agni, near (अभीके (*abhīke*), "near"; अभीक इत्यंतिकनामैतत् (*abhīka ityaṃtikanāmaitat*)) the gods, Indra and the rest, and also the mortals, men — whatever sin we have committed — may we, your friends, your praisers, never be harmed (मा रिषाम (*mā riṣāma*)) by (महश्चित् (*mahaścit*)) this great, unprecedented, extensive offence (एनसः (*enasaḥ*)). O Agni, give (यच्छ (*yaccha*)) to our son (तोकाय (*tokāya*)) and grandson (तनयाय (*tanayāya*)) शं (*śaṃ*), the quieting of the troubles that take the form of sin, and योः (*yoḥ*), happiness produced by good deeds.

Word-to-word meaning

- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- देवानां (*devānāṃ*)—in the matter of the gods
- उत (*uta*)—and
- मर्त्यानां (*martyānāṃ*)—of men

- अभीके(*abhīke*)—near
- ते (*te*)—your
- सखायः (*sakhāyaḥ*)—we, who are your friends
- महश्चित् (*mahaścit*)—from the very great
- ऊर्वात् (*ūrvāt*)—and extensive
- एनसः (*enasaḥ*)—fruit arising from sin
- सदमित् (*sadamit*)—always
- मा रिषाम (*mā riṣāma*)—may we not be harmed
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- तोकाय (*tokāya*)—to our sons
- तनयाय (*tanayāya*)—and grandsons
- शं (*śaṃ*)—sin-free peace
- योः (*yoḥ*)—and happiness
- यच्छ (*yaccha*)—give

Gist

O Agni, grant that we, your friends, when through ignorance we have committed sin, may receive no kind of harm from the gods or from men. Even if our sin is very great, let its fruit not harm us. O Agni, give to our sons and grandsons also sin-free peace and happiness.

English translation

Let not us, Agni, who are your friends, ever suffer harm from any great or comprehensive offence against either gods or men: bestow forgiveness upon our sons and grandsons, the reward of what has been well done.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यथा॑ ह॒ त्यद्व॑सवो गौ॒र्यं॑ चित्प॒दि षि॒ताम॑मु॑ंञ्चता यज
त्राः ।
ए॒वो ष्व१॒॑स्मन्मु॑ंञ्चता॒ व्यंह॒ः प्र ता॑र्यग्ने प्रत॒रं न॒
आयु॑ः ॥ ६ ॥

> *yathā ha tyadvasavo gauryaṃ citpadi ṣitāmamuñcatā yajatrāḥ |*
> *evo ṣvasmanmuñcatā vyaṃhaḥ pra tāryagne prataraṃ na āyuḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यथा । ह । त्यत् । वसवः । गौर्यं । चित् । पदि । सितां । अमुंचत । यजत्राः ।
> एवो इति । सु । अस्मत् । मुंचत । वि । अंहः । प्र । तारि । अग्ने । प्रतरं । नः ।
> आयुः ॥ ६ ॥

> *yathā | ha | tyat | vasavaḥ | gauryaṃ | cit | padi | sitāṃ | amuṃcata |*
> *yajatrāḥ |*
> *evo iti | su | asmat | muṃcata | vi | aṃhaḥ | pra | tāri | agne |*
> *prataraṃ | naḥ |*
> *āyuḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यजत्रा यजनीयाः पूजार्हा हे वसवो निवासयितारोऽग्नयो
> यूयं यथा ह यथैव त्यत्यां तां पदि पादे सितां बद्धां गौर्यं चित् गौरीं
> गामप्यमुंचत । त्यक्तवंतो भूयास्त । एवो एवमेवास्मदस्मत्तोऽहः पापं
> सु अत्यंतं वि मुंचत । विमुक्तं कुरुत । बहुवचनं पूजार्थं । हे अग्ने त्वया
> प्रतरं प्रवृद्धं नोऽस्मदीयमायुः प्र तारि । प्रवृद्धं क्रियता ॥

> *yajatrā yajanīyāḥ pūjārhā he vasavo nivāsayitāro 'gnayo*
> *yūyaṃ yathā ha yathaiva tyatyāṃ tāṃ padi pāde sitāṃ baddhāṃ*
> *gauryaṃ cit gaurīṃ*
> *gāmapyamuṃcata | tyaktavaṃto bhūyāsta | evo evamevāsmadasmatto*
> *'haḥ pāpaṃ*

> *su atyaṃtaṃ vi muṃcata | vimuktaṃ kuruta | bahuvacanaṃ pūjārthaṃ | he agne tvayā*
> *prataraṃ pravṛddhaṃ no 'smadīyamāyuḥ pra tāri | pravṛddhaṃ kriyatā ||*

Summary

Sāyaṇa addresses the Vasus: "O यजत्रा (*yajatrā*), worthy of worship, O Vasus, Agnis who give dwelling." He says: "Just as you released even the cow Gaurī that was bound by the foot, so release sin from us completely." The plural (बहुवचनं (*bahuvacanaṃ*)) is for honour. Then, addressing Agni: "By you let our life be made प्रतरं (*prataraṃ*), that is, increased (प्रवृद्धं (*pravṛddhaṃ*)); let it be made to grow."

Word-to-word meaning

- यजत्राः (*yajatrāḥ*)—O you who are worthy of worship
- वसवः (*vasavaḥ*)—Agnis who give dwelling
- यथा ह (*yathā ha*)—in what manner
- त्यत् (*tyat*)—that famous one
- पदि (*padi*)—at the foot
- सितां (*sitāṃ*)—bound
- गौर्यं चित् (*gauryaṃ cit*)—the cow also
- अमुंचत (*amuṃcata*)—you caused to be freed
- एवो (*evo*)—in the same manner
- अस्मत् (*asmat*)—from us
- अ०हः (*aohaḥ*)—sin
- सु (*su*)—completely
- वि मुंचत (*vi muṃcata*)—release and destroy
- अग्ने (*agne*)—O Agni
- प्रतरं (*prataraṃ*)—most dear[?440]
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- आयुः (*āyuḥ*)—life
- प्र तारि (*pra tāri*)—graciously grant that it grow

Gist

O Agnis, worthy of worship and givers of dwelling, in the manner in which you caused even the famous cow, bound at the foot, to be freed, in the same manner release sin from us also and destroy it completely. By your favour may our dear life attain increase.

English translation

Adorable Vasus, in like manner as you have liberated the cow bound by the foot, so set us free entirely from sin; and may our existence, be prolonged.

Sūkta 13 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> प्रत्यग्निरिति पंचर्चं तृतीयं सूक्तं नामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभमाग्नेयं तत्तन्मंत्रवर्णाभिधेयोषःप्रभृतिदैवतं वा । तथा चानुक्रांतं । प्रत्यग्निः पंच लिंगोक्तदैवतं त्वेक इति ॥ लैंगिको विनियोगः ॥

> *pratyagniriti paṃcarcaṃ tṛtīyaṃ sūktaṃ nāmadevasyārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhamāgneyaṃ tattanmaṃtravarṇābhidheyoṣaḥprabhṛtidaivataṃ vā | tathā cānukrāṃtaṃ | pratyagniḥ paṃca liṃgoktadaivataṃ tveka iti ‖ laiṃgiko viniyogaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta प्रत्यग्निः (*pratyagniḥ*) of five verses is the third sūkta. Its seer is Vāmadeva, its metre Triṣṭubh, and its deity Agni; or else its deities are those denoted by the words of the respective mantras, beginning with Uṣas. So the Anukramaṇī says: प्रत्यग्निः पंच लिंगोक्तदैवतं त्वेक इति (*pratyagniḥ paṃca liṃgoktadaivataṃ tveka iti*)[?441]. The application is by the indicatory mark (लैंगिको विनियोगः (*laiṃgiko viniyogaḥ*)).

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning "Pratyagniḥ" is the third sūkta in the second anuvāka. It has five ṛks. Its seer is Vāmadeva; its deity is Agni; its metre is Triṣṭup. In this sūkta, along with the Agni praised in the respective ṛks, Savitṛ and the others are the deities of the respective ṛks. The Anukramaṇī says: "Pratyagniḥ pañca liṅgoktadaivataṃ taike." The application is by indicatory mark.

Sūkta—13

Maṇḍala—4; Anuvāka—2; Sūkta—13

Aṣṭaka—3; Adhyāya—5; Varga—13

Number of ṛks in the sūkta—5

Ṛṣi—Vāmadeva

Devatā—Agni

Chandas—Triṣṭup

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्रत्य॒ग्निरु॒षसा॒मग्रं॑मख्यद्विभाती॒नां सु॒मना॑ रत्न॒धेयं॑म् ।
या॒तमं॑श्विना सु॒कृतो॑ दु॒रो॒णमुत्सूर्यो॒॑ ज्योतिं॑षा दे॒व एं॑ति ॥ १ ॥

> *pratyagniruṣasāmagramakhyadvibhātīnāṃ sumanā ratnadheyam |*
> *yātamaśvinā sukṛto duroṇamutsūryo jyotiṣā deva eti ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्रति । अग्निः । उषसां । अग्रं । अख्यत् । विभातीनां । सुमनाः । रत्नधेयं ।
> यातं । अश्विना । सुकृतः । दुरोणं । उत् । सूर्यः । ज्योतिषा । देवः । एति ॥

> *prati | agniḥ | uṣasām | agram | akhyat | vibhātīnām | sumanāḥ | ratnadheyaṃ |*
> *yātaṃ | aśvinā | sukṛtaḥ | duroṇaṃ | ut | sūryaḥ | jyotiṣā | devaḥ | eti ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सुमनाः शोभनमनस्कोग्निर्विभातीनां व्युच्छंतीनामुषसामुषोदेवतानां रत्नधेयं रत्नधानं । धनप्रकाशकमित्यर्थः । अग्रं प्रति पूर्वकालं लक्षीकृ–

> *sumanāḥ śobhanamanaskognirvibhātīnāṃ vyucchaṃtīnāmuṣasāmuṣodevatānāṃ ratnadheyaṃ ratnadhānaṃ | dhanaprakāśakamityarthaḥ | agraṃ prati pūrvakālaṃ lakṣīkṛ-*

> त्याख्यत् । प्रवृद्धो भवति । हे अश्विनास्विन् युवां सुकृतो यजमानस्य दुरोणं गृहं । दुरोण इति गृहनाम दुरोणे दुर्या इति गृहनामसु पाठात् । यातं । गच्छतं । सूर्य ऋत्विगादीनां प्रेरको देवो ज्योतिषा स्वेन तेजसोदेति । उषःकाले प्रादुर्भवतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *tyākhyat | pravṛddo bhavati | he aśvināsvin yuvāṃ sukṛto yajamānasya duroṇaṃ*
> *gṛhaṃ | duroṇa iti gṛhanāma duroṇe duryā iti gṛhanāmasu pāṭhāt | yātaṃ |*
> *gacchataṃ | sūrya ṛtvigādīnāṃ prerako devo jyotiṣā svena tejasodeti | uṣaḥkāle prādurbhavatītyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*) is Agni of good mind. विभातीनां (*vibhātīnāṃ*) means of the dawns (Uṣas deities) that are shining forth. रत्नधेयं (*ratnadheyaṃ*) is "the bearer of wealth", that is, it reveals wealth. Taking as his aim the front part (अग्रं प्रति (*agraṃ prati*)) at the earlier time, he अख्यत् (*akhyat*): he becomes fully grown. (The sentence continues on the next page.)

"O Aśvins, go (यातं (*yātaṃ*)) to the house (दुरोणं (*duroṇaṃ*)) of the sacrificer who does good deeds." दुरोण (*duroṇa*) is a name for "house", because it is read among the names of house: दुरोणे दुर्या इति गृहनामसु पाठात् (*duroṇe duryā iti gṛhanāmasu pāṭhāt*). Sūrya, the god who impels the priests and others, rises with his own splendour; that is, he appears at the time of dawn.

Word-to-word meaning

- सुमनाः (*sumanāḥ*)—of excellent mind
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- विभातीनां (*vibhātīnāṃ*)—of those that shine widely
- उषसां (*uṣasāṃ*)—of the dawn goddesses
- रत्नधेयं (*ratnadheyaṃ*)—that which reveals wealth
- अग्रं प्रति (*agraṃ prati*)—with regard to the front part, which is full of radiance
- अख्यत् (*akhyat*)—has shone, fully grown
- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—O Aśvin deities
- सुकृतः (*sukṛtaḥ*)—of the sacrificer who does good deeds
- दुरोणु (*duroṇu*)—the house
- यातं (*yātaṃ*)—come and join
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—the one who is of divine nature

- सूर्यः (*sūryaḥ*)—Sūrya, the impeller of priests and others
- ज्योतिषा (*jyotiṣā*)—with his own radiance
- उदेति (*udeti*)—has appeared

Gist

Agni, of excellent mind, has shone, grown, having regard to the front part of the widely radiant dawn goddesses, which reveals wealth and is full of radiance. O Aśvin deities, come to the house of the sacrificer who does good deeds. Sūrya, who is of divine nature and the impeller of priests and others, has appeared with his own radiance.

English translation

Favourably-minded, Agni has manifested (his might) in regard to the wealth-bestowing procession of the resplendent dawns : proceed, Ashwins, to the dwelling of the pious (worshipper) : the divine sun rises with splendour.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऊ॒र्ध्वं भा॒नुं स॑वि॒ता दे॒वो अ॑श्रेद्द्र॒प्सं दवि॑ध्वद्ग॒विषो
न सत्वा॑ ।
अनु॑ व्र॒तं वरु॑णो यन्ति मि॒त्रो यत्सूर्यं॑ दि॒व्या॑रो॒हय॑
न्ति ॥ २ ॥

> *ūrdhvaṃ bhānuṃ savitā devo aśreddrapsaṃ davidhvadgaviṣo na satvā |*
> *anu vrataṃ varuṇo yanti mitro yatsūryaṃ divyārohayanti ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऊर्ध्वं । भानुं । सविता । देवः । अश्रेत् । द्रप्सं । दविध्वत् । गोऽइषः । न ।
> सत्वा ।
> अनु । व्रतं । वरुणः । यंति । मित्रः । यत् । सूर्यं । दिवि । आरोहयंति ॥२॥

> *ūrdhvaṃ | bhānuṃ | savitā | devaḥ | aśret | drapsaṃ | davidhvat | go 'iṣaḥ | na |*
> *satvā |*
> *anu | vrataṃ | varuṇaḥ | yaṃti | mitraḥ | yat | sūryaṃ | divi | ārohayaṃti ‖2‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सविता प्रेरको देव ऊर्ध्वमुन्मुखं भानुमश्रेत् । आश्रयति । यद्यदा
> रश्मयः सूर्यं दिवि द्युलोक आरोहयंति । आरोहणं कारयंति । तदा
> वरुणो रात्र्यभिमानी देवो मित्रोऽहरभिमान्यन्ने देवाश्च व्रतं तत्संबंधि
> कर्मानु यंति । अनुगच्छंति । अनुगमने दृष्टांत उच्यते । द्रप्पं पार्थिवं रजो
> दविध्वद्धुन्वन् । विकिरन्नित्यर्थः । गविषो गा इच्छन् सत्वा न वृषभ इव तद्वत् ॥

> *savitā prerako deva ūrdhvamunmukhaṃ bhānumaśret | āśrayati | yadyadā*
> *raśmayaḥ sūryaṃ divi dyuloka ārohayaṃti | ārohaṇaṃ kārayaṃti | tadā*
> *varuṇo rātryabhimānī devo mitro 'harabhimānyanne devāśca vrataṃ tatsaṃbaṃdhi*
> *karmānu yaṃti | anugacchaṃti | anugamane dṛṣṭāṃta ucyate | drappaṃ pārthivaṃ rajo*
> *davidhvaddunvan | vikirannityarthaḥ | gaviṣo gā icchan satvā na vṛṣabha iva tadvat ‖*

Summary

Savitṛ, the impelling god, takes refuge in (obtains) the upward-facing light (भानुं (*bhānuṃ*)). When (यत् (*yat*)) the rays make Sūrya ascend in the sky, in heaven, then Varuṇa, the deity presiding over night, Mitra, the deity presiding over day, and the other gods follow the व्रतं (*vrataṃ*), the work connected with it (their own duty). An illustration of the following is given: like a bull that is desirous of cows, shaking and scattering the earthly dust (द्रप्पं (*drappaṃ*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- देवः (*devaḥ*)—the one of divine nature
- सविता (*savitā*)—Savitṛ
- ऊर्ध्वं (*ūrdhvaṃ*)—facing upward

भानुं (*bhānuṃ*)	the light (his own radiance)
अश्रेत् (*aśret*)	takes refuge in (obtains)
यत् (*yat*)	when
सूर्यं (*sūryaṃ*)	Sūrya
दिवि (*divi*)	in heaven
आरोहयंति (*ārohayaṃti*)	(the rays) make him climb (then)
वरुणः (*varuṇaḥ*)	Varuṇa
मित्रः (*mitraḥ*)	Mitra also (the other deities too)
द्रप्सं (*drapsaṃ*)	the earthly dust
दधिध्वत् (*dadhidhvat*)	stirring up and scattering all around
गविषः (*gaviṣaḥ*)	desiring to join the cow
सत्वा न (*satvā na*)	like a bull (in eagerness)
व्रतं (*vrataṃ*)	their respective duties
अनु यंति (*anu yaṃti*)	follow and observe

Gist

The divine Savitṛ, rising facing upward, obtains his own radiance. When the rays make Sūrya climb in the sky, that is, when Sūrya, endowed with rays, ascends the sky, then Varuṇa, Mitra and the other deities also, eagerly, like a bull seeking a cow, stirring up the dust on the ground and scattering it all around and following the cow alone, follow and observe their own duties and functions.

English translation

The divine Savitri diffuses his light on high, dispersing the dew, and like a vigorous (bull) ardent for the cow : then Varuna, and Mitra, and other (divinities), hasten to (fulfil) their offices when they elevate the sun in the sky.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यं सी॒मकृ॑ण्व॒न्तम॑से वि॒पृचे॑ ध्रु॒वक्षे॑मा॒ अन॑वस्यन्तो॒ अर्थ॑म् ।
तं सूर्यं॑ ह॒रित॑ः स॒प्त य॒ह्वीः स्प॒शं विश्व॑स्य॒ जग॑तो वहन्ति ॥ ३ ॥

> *yaṃ sīmakṛṇvantamase viprce dhruvakṣemā anavasyanto artham |*
> *taṃ sūryaṃ haritaḥ sapta yahvīḥ spaśaṃ viśvasya jagato vahanti ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यं । सीं । अकृण्वन् । तमसे । विपृचे । ध्रुवक्षेमाः । अनवस्यंतः । अर्थं ।
> तं । सूर्यं । हरितः । सप्त । यह्वीः । स्पशं । विश्वस्य । जगतः । वहंति ॥ ३ ॥

> *yaṃ | sīṃ | akṛṇvan | tamase | viprce | dhruvakṣemāḥ | anavasyaṃtaḥ | arthaṃ |*
> *taṃ | sūryaṃ | haritaḥ | sapta | yahvīḥ | spaśaṃ | viśvasya | jagataḥ | vahaṃti ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ध्रुवक्षेमाः स्थिरनिवासाः सृष्टिकर्तारो देवाः सीं सर्वतस्तमसे तमसो
> विपृचे पृथक्करणायार्थं जगल्लक्षणं कार्यमनवस्यंतोऽविमुंचंतः कुर्वंत एव
> यं सूर्यमकृण्वन् । असृजन्नित्यर्थः । यह्वीर्महत्यः सप्त सप्तसंख्याका हरितोऽश्वा विश्वस्य
> समस्तस्य जगतः प्राणिसमूहस्य स्वशं प्रेरकत्वेन ज्ञातारं तं
> सूर्यं वहंति । धारयंति ॥

> *dhruvakṣemāḥ sthiranivāsāḥ sṛṣṭikartāro devāḥ sīṃ sarvatastamase tamaso*
> *viprce pṛthakkaraṇāyārthaṃ jagallakṣaṇaṃ kāryamanavasyaṃto 'vimuṃcaṃtaḥ kurvaṃta eva*
> *yaṃ sūryamakṛṇvan | asṛjannityarthaḥ | yahvīrmahatyaḥ sapta*

> *saptasaṃkhyākā harito 'śvā viśvasya samastasya jagataḥ prāṇisamūhasya svaśaṃ prerakatvena jñātāraṃ taṃ sūryaṃ vahaṃti | dhārayaṃti ||*

Summary

The ध्रुवक्षेमाः (*dhruvakṣemāḥ*) are the gods of firm abode, the creators. All around (सीं (*sīṃ*)), for separating (विपृचे (*vipṛce*)) from darkness (तमसे (*tamase*)), never leaving off (अनवस्यंतः (*anavasyaṃtaḥ*)) but continually doing the work (अर्थं (*arthaṃ*)) that has the form of the world, they made (अकृण्वन् (*akṛṇvan*)), that is, created, Sūrya. Seven great (यह्वीः (*yahvīḥ*)) horses (हरितः (*haritaḥ*)) carry that Sūrya, known (स्पशं (*spaśaṃ*)) as the impeller of the whole world, of the entire multitude of beings; वहंति (*vahaṃti*) means they bear him.

Word-to-word meaning

- ध्रुवक्षेमाः (*dhruvakṣemāḥ*)—gods of firm abode
- सीं (*sīṃ*)—all around
- तमसे (*tamase*)—of darkness
- विपृचे (*vipṛce*)—for separation
- अर्थं (*arthaṃ*)—the work that has the form of the world
- अनवस्यंतः (*anavasyaṃtaḥ*)—doing without cease
- यं (*yaṃ*)—whom
- अकृण्वन् (*akṛṇvan*)—they created
- तं (*taṃ*)—such a one
- विश्वस्य (*viśvasya*)—of the whole
- जगतः (*jagataḥ*)—of the entire multitude of beings
- स्पशं (*spaśaṃ*)—the one known as the impeller
- सूर्यं (*sūryaṃ*)—Sūrya
- यह्वीः (*yahvīḥ*)—possessing greatness
- सप्त (*sapta*)—seven in number
- हरितः (*haritaḥ*)—horses
- वहंति (*vahaṃti*)—bear

Gist

The gods of firm abode, continually doing the work that has the form of the world in order to destroy darkness, created Sūrya, who is known as the impeller of the entire multitude of beings; the great seven horses bear that Sūrya.

English translation

Seven great coursers convey that sun, whom the (deities), occupants of enduring mansions, and not heedless (of their offices), have formed for the driving away of darkness, (and who is) the animator of the whole world.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

वहि॑ष्ठेभिर्वि॒हर॑न्यासि॒ तन्तु॑मव॒व्यय॒न्नसि॑तं देव॒ वस्म॑ ।
दवि॑ध्वतो र॒श्मय॒ः सूर्य॑स्य॒ चर्मे॒वावा॑धु॒स्तमो॑ अ॒प्स्व१॒॑न्तः ॥ ४ ॥

> *vahiṣṭhebhirviharanyāsi tantumavavyayannasitaṃ deva vasma |*
> *davidhvato raśmayaḥ sūryasya carmevāvādhustamo apsvantaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> वहिष्ठेभिः । विहरन् । यासि । तंतुं । अवव्ययन् । असितं । देव । वस्म ।
> दविध्वतः । रश्मयः । सूर्यस्य । चर्मइव । अव । अधुः । तमः । अप्सु ।
> अंतरिति ॥ ४ ॥

> *vahiṣṭhebhiḥ | viharan | yāsi | taṃtuṃ | avavyayan | asitaṃ | deva | vasma |*
> *davidhvataḥ | raśmayaḥ | sūryasya | carmaiva | ava | adhuḥ | tamaḥ | apsu |*
> *aṃtariti ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे देव द्योतमान सूर्य त्वं जगन्निर्वाहात्मकस्य रसस्यादानार्थ० तंतुं
> रश्मिसमूहं विहरन्विस्तारयन् असितं कृष्णवर्णं वस्म नक्तंचराणां निवासभूतां
> रात्रिमवव्ययन् अवाचीनं यथा भवति तथा संवृण्वन् । तिरस्कुर्वन्नित्यर्थः ।
> वहिष्ठेभिर्वोढुमत्यंतं शक्त्यैरश्वैर्यासि । गमनमार्गं गच्छसि । अस्यामृचि पूर्वार्धे सूर्यस्य
> प्रत्यक्षमर्थ० प्रतिपाद्योत्तरार्धे परोक्षनुर्थ० प्रतिपादयितुमाह।
> दविध्वतो धुनानाः सूयर्स्य संबंधिनो रश्मयः किरणा अप्स्वंतरिक्षे । आस
> इत्यंतरिक्षनाम आकाशमापः पृथिवीति तन्नामसु पाठात् । अंतर्मध्ये चर्मेव
> चर्मवत्स्थितं तमोऽंधकारमवाधुः । अवाचीनमदधुः । तिरस्कुर्वंतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *he deva dyotamāna sūrya tvaṃ jagannirvāhātmakasya rasasyādānārthao taṃtuṃ*
> *raśmisamūhaṃ viharanvistārayan asitaṃ kṛṣṇavarṇaṃ vasma naktaṃcarāṇāṃ nivāsabhūtāṃ*
> *rātrimavavyayan avācīnaṃ yathā bhavati tathā saṃvṛṇvan | tiraskurvannityarthaḥ | vahiṣṭhebhirvoḍhumatyaṃtaṃ śaktyairaśvairyāsi | gamanamārgaṃ gacchasi | asyāmṛci pūrvārdhe sūryasya pratyakṣamarthao pratipādyottarārdhe parokṣanurthao pratipādayitumāha|*
> *davidhvato dhunānāḥ sūyarsya saṃbaṃdhino raśmayaḥ kiraṇā apsvaṃtarikṣe | āsa*
> *ityaṃtarikṣanāma ākāśamāpaḥ pṛthivīti tannāmasu pāṭhāt | aṃtarmadhyè carmeva*
> *carmavatsthitaṃ tamo 'ṃdhakāramavādhuḥ | avācīnamadadhuḥ | tiraskurvaṃtītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

"O god, shining Sūrya, you spread (विहरन् (*viharan*)) the तंतुं (*taṃtuṃ*), the mass of rays, in order to take the sap that sustains the world. Shutting out downward the black-coloured वस्म (*vasma*), the night that is the dwelling of the night-wanderers, that is, putting it down, you travel with the very strong bearers (वहिष्ठेभिः (*vahiṣṭhebhiḥ*)), the horses; you go on your path of travel." In this ṛk, having stated in the first half the visible matter concerning Sūrya, in the second half he speaks to state the invisible matter: the shaking rays belonging to Sūrya, अप्सु (*apsu*), in the atmosphere (आस इत्यंतरिक्षनाम आकाशमापः पृथिवीति तन्नामसु पाठात् (*āsa ityaṃtarikṣanāma ākāśamāpaḥ pṛthivīti tannāmasu* *pāṭhāt*): "āpas" is a name of the atmosphere, because it is read among its names), in the middle, cast down (*avādhuḥ*) the darkness that stands like a skin (चर्मेव (*carmeva*)); they put it down, they set it aside.

Word-to-word meaning

- देव (*deva*)—O shining Sūrya
- तंतुं (*taṃtuṃ*)—(your) mass of rays
- विहरन् (*viharan*)—spreading (for taking the sap)
- असितं (*asitaṃ*)—black-coloured
- वस्म (*vasma*)—and the dwelling of the rākṣasas?[442]
- …the night. (अवव्ययन् (*avavyayan*))—bringing to an end
- वहिष्ठेभिः (*vahiṣṭhebhiḥ*)—with horses having the power of carrying
- यासि (*yāsi*)—you travel
- सूर्यस्य (*sūryasya*)—of the sun
- दविध्वतः (*davidhvataḥ*)—trembling
- रश्मयः (*raśmayaḥ*)—rays
- अप्सु (*apsu*)—of the firmament
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the middle region
- चर्मेव (*carmeva*)—spread like a skin
- तमः (*tamaḥ*)—the darkness
- अवाधुः (*avādhuḥ*)—they destroy

Gist

O shining Sun, spreading out your mass of rays for the drawing up of the waters, and bringing to an end the night, which is black in colour and the dwelling of the rākṣasas, you travel with horses that have the power of carrying. The trembling rays of the Sun destroy the darkness that is spread like a skin in the middle region of the firmament.

English translation

Divine (sun), you proceed with most powerful (horses), spreading your web (of rays), and cutting down the black abode (of night); the tremulous rays of the sun throw off the darkness which is spread like a skin over the firmament.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अना॑यतो॒ अनि॑बद्धः क॒थायं न्यं॑ङ्ङुत्ता॒नोऽव॑ पद्य॒ते न ।
कया॑ याति स्व॒धया॒ को दं॑दर्श दि॒वः स्क॒म्भः समृ॑तः पाति॒ नाकं॑म् ॥ ५ ॥

> *anāyato anibaddhaḥ kathāyaṃ nyaṅṅuttāno 'va padyate na |*
> *kayā yāti svadhayā ko dadarśa divaḥ skambhaḥ samṛtaḥ pāti nākam ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अनायतः । अनिबद्धः । कथा । अयं । न्यज् । उत्तानः । अव । पद्यते । न ।
> कया । याति । स्वधया । कः । ददर्श । दिवः । स्कंभः । संऋतः । पाति । नाकं ॥ ५ ॥

> *anāyataḥ | anibaddhaḥ | kathā | ayaṃ | nyaj | uttānaḥ | ava | padyate | na |*
> *kayā | yāti | svadhayā | kaḥ | dadarśa | divaḥ | skaṃbhaḥ | saṃṛtaḥ | pāti | nākaṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आयतशब्दो दूरवाची । तद्विपरितोऽनायत आसीनः सन्नयं प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानो मंडलाभिमानी सूर्योऽनिबद्धः । केनापि बद्धो न क्रियते । अपि

> *āyataśabdo dūravācī | tadviparito 'nāyata āsīnaḥ sannayaṃ pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamāno maṃḍalābhimānī sūryo 'nibaddhaḥ | kenāpi baddho na kriyate | api*

> चायं सूरो नृज्जुर्वाङ्मुखः सन् केनचित्कथा कथं नाव पद्यते । न हिंस्यते । किंचायमुत्तान ऊर्ध्वमुखत्वेन तिष्ठन् कया स्वधया केन बलेन याति । गच्छति । स्वधाशब्दोऽन्नवाच्यत्र तत्कार्यं बलं लक्षयति । अपि च दिवो द्युलोकस्य स्कंभः स्तंभः समृतो नाकेन समवेतः सूर्यो नाकं स्वर्गं पाति । पालयति । को ददर्श । तत्त्वतः कः पश्यति । न कोऽपि जानातीत्यर्थः ॥

> *cāyaṃ sūro nṛjjurvāṅmukhaḥ san kenacitkathā kathaṃ nāva padyate |*
> *na hiṃsyate |*
> *kiṃcāyamuttāna ūrdhvamukhatvena tiṣṭhan kayā svadhayā kena balena*
> *yāti | gacchati |*
> *svadhāśabdo 'nnavācyatra tatkāryaṃ balaṃ lakṣayati | api ca divo*
> *dyulokasya skaṃbhaḥ*
> *staṃbhaḥ samṛto nākena samavetaḥ sūryo nākaṃ svargaṃ pāti |*
> *pālayati | ko*
> *dadarśa | tattvataḥ kaḥ paśyati | na ko 'pi jānātītyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

The word आयत (*āyata*) means "far". Its opposite is अनायत (*anāyata*), "near": this sun, the deity of the disc, who is seen directly, is अनिबद्ध (*anibaddha*), not bound, not made captive by anyone. (The sentence continues in the next block.)

Moreover, this sun, though moving with his face turned downwards, how is he not harmed by anyone? And standing with his face turned upwards (उत्तान (*uttāna*)), by what स्वधया (*svadhayā*)—by what strength—does he travel? The word स्वधा (*svadhā*) here means food and points to the strength that results from it. Further, the Sun, the pillar of heaven, joined with the sky (नाक (*nāka*)), protects the heaven. Who has truly seen this? No one knows it, is the meaning.

Word-to-word meaning

- अनायतः (*anāyataḥ*)—one who moves near
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this Sun, who is also of the form of a disc
- अनिबद्धः (*anibaddhaḥ*)—has a course that is checked by no one
- न्यङ्क (*nyaṅka*)—even while moving with face turned downwards
- कथा (*kathā*)—how
- न अव पद्यते (*na ava padyate*)—is not harmed by anyone
- उत्तानः (*uttānaḥ*)—being with face turned upwards
- कया स्वधया (*kayā svadhayā*)—with what strength
- याति (*yāti*)—he travels
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the heavenly world

- स्कंभः (*skaṃbhaḥ*)—like a pillar
- समृतः (*samṛtaḥ*)—dwelling in the firmament[?443]
- the Sun—नाकं (*nākaṃ*) heaven; पाति (*pāti*)—protects, this matter
- को ददर्श (*ko dadarśa*)—who indeed could have seen it in truth

Gist

The Sun, who moves near and is of the form of a disc, has a course that is checked by no one. Even while moving with face turned downwards, how is he not harmed by anyone? With what strength does he travel while facing upwards? The Sun, who is like a pillar of the heavenly world and dwells in the firmament, protects heaven. Who indeed can know in truth such a Sun, of such great deeds?

English translation

This sun, not far removed, and unobstructed, whether (looking) down- wards or looking upwards, is harmed by no one: what is the power by which he travels? who has (truly) beheld him who, as the collective pillar of heaven, sustains the sky ?

Sūkta 14 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> प्रत्यग्निरुषस इति पंचर्चं चतुर्थं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं त्रैष्टुभमाग्नेयं मांत्रवर्णिकदैवतं वा । तथा चानुक्रांतं । प्रत्यग्निरिति । लिंगोक्तदैवतं
> त्विति तुशब्दादस्यापि सूक्तस्य लिंगोक्तदैवतत्वं ॥ विनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥

> *pratyagniruṣasa iti paṃcarcaṃ caturthaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ traiṣṭubhamāgneyaṃ māṃtravarṇikadaivataṃ vā | tathā cānukrāṃtaṃ | pratyagniriti | liṃgoktadaivataṃ*
> *tviti tuśabdādasyāpi sūktasya liṃgoktadaivatatvaṃ ‖ viniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

This sūkta beginning प्रत्यग्निरुषसः (*pratyagniruṣasaḥ*), of five verses, is the fourth sūkta. Its seer is Vāmadeva; its metre is triṣṭubh; its deity is Agni, or else the deities named in the mantras. So the Anukramaṇī says, beginning प्रत्यग्निः (*pratyagniḥ*); by the word तु (*tu*) in लिंगोक्तदैवतं तु (*liṃgoktadaivataṃ tu*) this sūkta too has deities as indicated by the text. The application (viniyoga) is as indicated by the text (लैंगिकः (*laiṃgikaḥ*)).

Anuvāda

This sūkta प्रत्यग्निरुषसः (*pratyagniruṣasaḥ*) is the fourth sūkta in the second anuvāka. It has five ṛks. The seer of this sūkta is Vāmadeva; the deity is Agni, or else the others who are spoken of in the mantras; the metre is triṣṭubh. In the Anukramaṇī it begins with प्रत्यग्निः (*pratyagniḥ*). Because the word तु (*tu*) is used in लिंगोक्तदैवतं तु (*liṃgoktadaivataṃ tu*), the deities of this sūkta are those who are praised in the respective mantras. The application is as indicated by the text.

Particulars

- Sūkta 14
- Maṇḍala 4; Anuvāka 2; Sūkta 14

- Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 5; Varga 14
- Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 5
- Ṛṣi: Vāmadeva
- Devatā: Agni, or the deities indicated by the text
- Chandas: Triṣṭubh

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प्रत्य॒ग्निरु॒षसो॑ जा॒तवे॑दा॒ अख्य॑द्दे॒वो रोच॑माना॒ महो॑भिः ।
आ ना॑सत्योरुगा॒या रथे॑ने॒मं य॒ज्ञमुप॑ नो यात॒मच्छ॑ ॥ १ ॥

> *pratyagniruṣaso jātavedā akhyaddevo rocamānā mahobhiḥ |*
> *ā nāsatyorugāyā rathenemaṃ yajñamupa no yātamaccha ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> प्रति । अग्निः । उषसः । जातवेदाः । अख्यत् । देवः । रोचमानाः । महभिः ।
> आ । नासत्या । उरुगाया । रथेन । इमं । यज्ञं । उप । नः । यातं । अच्छ ॥

> *prati | agniḥ | uṣasaḥ | jātavedāḥ | akhyat | devaḥ | rocamānāḥ | mahabhiḥ |*
> *ā | nāsatyā | urugāyā | rathena | imaṃ | yajñaṃ | upa | naḥ | yātaṃ | accha ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवो द्योतमानो जातवेदा जातधनोऽग्निर्महोभिस्तेजोभी रोचमाना दीप्यमाना उषसः प्रत्युषसो लक्ष्मीकृत्याख्यत् । प्रवृद्धो भवति । उरुगाया प्रभूतगमनौ हे नासत्याश्विन् रथेन नोऽस्मदीयमिमं यज्ञमच्छाभिमुखमुप यातु । उपगच्छतं ॥

> *devo dyotamāno jātavedā jātadhano 'gnirmahobhistejobhī rocamānā dīpyamānā uṣasaḥ pratyuṣaso lakṣmīkṛtyākhyat | pravṛddho bhavati | urugāyā prabhūtagamanau he nāsatyāśvin rathena no 'smadīyamimaṃ yajñamacchābhimukhamupa yātu | upagacchataṃ ||*

Summary

Agni, the shining god, जातवेदाः (*jātavedāḥ*)—one whose wealth is born—with his splendours, having made the shining, radiant dawns his aim, अख्यत् (*akhyat*): he becomes grown. O far-going Nāsatyas, Aśvins, may you come with your chariot toward this sacrifice of ours; approach it.

Word-to-word meaning

- देवः (*devaḥ*)—shining
- जातवेदाः (*jātavedāḥ*)—one of born wisdom
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- महोभिः (*mahobhiḥ*)—with splendours
- रोचमानाः (*rocamānāḥ*)—shining
- उषसः प्रति (*uṣasaḥ prati*)—toward the dawns
- अख्यत् (*akhyat*)—he grows
- उरुगाया (*urugāyā*)—you who are abundantly praised
- नासत्या (*nāsatyā*)—O Aśvin gods
- रथेन (*rathena*)—with your chariot
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- इमं यज्ञं (*imaṃ yajñaṃ*)—this sacrifice
- अच्छ (*accha*)—facing
- उप आ यातं (*upa ā yātaṃ*)—please come

Gist

Agni, who is shining, of born wisdom and of born wealth, grows for the dawns that shine with brilliance. O Aśvin gods, who are abundantly praised, come facing this sacrifice of ours, with your chariot.

English translation

The resplendent Agni, by whom all is known, has manifested (his might) in regard to the dawns radiant with lustre : far-going Nasatyas, come with your car to this our sacrifice.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ऊ॒र्ध्वं के॒तुं स॑वि॒ता दे॒वो अ॑श्रे॒ज्ज्योति॒र्विश्व॑स्मै॒ भुव॑नाय कृ॒ण्वन् ।
आप्रा॒ द्यावा॑पृथि॒वी अ॒न्तरि॑क्षं॒ वि सूर्यो॑ र॒श्मिभि॒श्चेकि॑तानः ॥ २ ॥

> *ūrdhvaṃ ketuṃ savitā devo aśrejjyotirviśvasmai bhuvanāya kṛṇvan |*
> *āprā dyāvāpṛthivī antarikṣaṃ vi sūryo raśmibhiścekitānaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ऊर्ध्वं । केतुं । सविता । देवः । अश्रेत् । ज्योतिः । विश्वस्मै । भुवनाय । कृण्वन् ।
> आ । अप्राः । द्यावापृथिवी इति । अंतरिक्षं । वि । सूर्यः । रश्मिभिः । चेकितानः ॥ २ ॥

> *ūrdhvaṃ | ketuṃ | savitā | devaḥ | aśret | jyotiḥ | viśvasmai | bhuvanāya | kṛṇvan |*
> *ā | aprāḥ | dyāvāpṛthivī iti | aṃtarikṣaṃ | vi | sūryaḥ | raśmibhiḥ | cekitānaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वस्मै सर्वस्मै भुवनाय लोकाय ज्योतिस्तेजः कृण्वन् कुर्वन् सविता प्रेरको देव ऊर्ध्वमुन्मुखं केतुं प्रकाशकं भानुमश्रेत् । आश्रयति । वि चेकितानः सर्वं विशेषेण पश्यन् सूर्यो रश्मिभिः स्वकीयैः किरणैर्द्यावापृथिवी द्युलोकभूलोकौ चांतरिक्षं चाप्राः । समंतादपूरयत् ॥

> *viśvasmai sarvasmai bhuvanāya lokāya jyotistejaḥ kṛṇvan kurvan savitā prerako deva ūrdhvamunmukhaṃ ketuṃ prakāśakaṃ bhānumaśret | āśrayati | vi*

> *cekitānaḥ sarvaṃ viśeṣeṇa paśyan sūryo raśmibhiḥ svakīyaiḥ*
> *kiraṇairdyāvāpṛthivī*
> *dyulokabhūlokau cāṃtarikṣaṃ cāprāḥ | samaṃtādapūrayat ||*

Summary

Savitṛ, the impelling god, making light, brilliance, for the whole world, resorts to the upward-turned केतु (*ketu*), the illuminating radiance (भानु (*bhānu*)). The Sun, who sees everything in particular, with his own rays filled heaven, earth and the firmament completely on every side.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वस्मै (*viśvasmai*)—for the whole
- भुवनाय (*bhuvanāya*)—world
- ज्योतिः (*jyotiḥ*)—brilliance
- कृण्वन् (*kṛṇvan*)—making
- सविता (*savitā*)—the impeller of the whole world
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—god Savitṛ
- ऊर्ध्वं (*ūrdhvaṃ*)—turned upward
- केतुं (*ketuṃ*)—the radiance (भानु (*bhānu*)) that shines like a banner
- अश्रेत् (*aśret*)—he resorts to
- वि चिकितानः (*vi cikitānaḥ*)—who sees everything in a special way
- सूर्यः (*sūryaḥ*)—the Sun
- रश्मिभिः (*raśmibhiḥ*)—with his rays
- द्यावापृथिवी (*dyāvāpṛthivī*)—heaven and earth
- अंतरिक्षं (*aṃtarikṣaṃ*)—the firmament
- आ प्राः (*ā prāḥ*)—has filled completely

Gist

Making brilliance for the whole world, the god Savitṛ, the impeller of the whole world, resorts, turned upward, to the radiance that shines like a banner. The Sun, who sees the whole world in a special way, has filled heaven, earth and the firmament completely with his rays.

English translation

The divine Savitri displays his banner on high, diffusing light through all worlds : contemplating (all things) the sun has filled heaven earth and the firmament with his rays.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ॒वह॑न्त्यरु॒णीर्ज्योंति॒षागा॑न्म॒ही चि॒त्रा र॒श्मिभि॒श्चेकि॑ताना ।
प्र॒बो॒धय॑न्ती सुवि॒ताय॑ दे॒व्यु१॒॑षा ई॑यते सु॒युजा॒ रथे॑न ॥ ३ ॥

> *āvahantyaruṇīrjyotiṣāgānmahī citrā raśmibhiścekitānā |*
> *prabodhayantī suvitāya devyuṣā īyate suyujā rathena ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आवहंती । अरुणीः । ज्योतिषा । आ । अगात् । मही । चित्रा । रश्मिभिः । चेकिताना॥
> प्रबोधयंती । सुविताय । देवी । उषाः । ईयते । सुयुजा । रथेन ॥ ३ ॥

> *āvahaṃtī | aruṇīḥ | jyotiṣā | ā | agāt | mahī | citrā | raśmibhiḥ | cekitānā‖*
> *prabodhayaṃtī | suvitāya | devī | uṣāḥ | īyate | suyujā | rathena ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आवहंती धनानि धारयंत्यरुणीररुणवर्णाः ॥ प्रथमैकवचने द्वितीयाबहुवचनं छांदसं ॥
> ज्योतिषा तेजसा युक्ता मही महती रश्मिभिः किरणैश्चित्रा
> दर्शनीया चेकिताना जानत्युषा आगात् । आगच्छत् । किंच प्रबोधयंती सुप्तान्
> प्रबुद्धान् कुर्वती देवी द्योतमानोषाः सुयुजा शोभनयुक्तन रथेन
> सुविताय सुखप्राप्तेय ईयते । गच्छति ॥

> *āvahaṃtī dhanāni dhārayaṃtyaruṇīraruṇavarṇāḥ ‖ prathamaikavacane dvitīyābahuvacanaṃ chāṃdasaṃ ‖ jyotiṣā tejasā yuktā mahī mahatī raśmibhiḥ kiraṇaiścitrā*

> *darśanīyā cekitānā jānatyuṣā āgāt | āgacchat | kiṃca prabodhayaṃtī suptān*
> *prabuddhān kurvatī devī dyotamānoṣāḥ suyujā śobhanayuktana rathena suvitāya sukhaprāptèya īyate | gacchati ||*

Summary

आवहंती (*āvahaṃtī*) is bearing wealth; अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*) is of red colour. Uṣas, joined with light, great, wonderful (beautiful to see) with her rays, knowing, has come. Moreover, arousing the sleepers, the shining Uṣas goes with her well-yoked chariot, सुविताय (*suvitāya*), for the one who has attained happiness.

Word-to-word meaning

- आवहंती (*āvahaṃtī*)—she who bears wealth
- अरुणीः (*aruṇīḥ*)—she who is of red colour
- ज्योतिषा (*jyotiṣā*)—endowed with splendour
- मही (*mahī*)—of great nature
- रश्मिभिः (*raśmibhiḥ*)—with rays
- चित्रा (*citrā*)—of attractive form
- चेकिताना (*cekitānā*)—knowing all affairs; Uṣas
- आगात् (*āgāt*)—comes, rising
- प्रबोधयंती (*prabodhayaṃtī*)—waking those who lie asleep
- देवी (*devī*)—shining
- उषाः (*uṣāḥ*)—Uṣas
- सुयुजा (*suyujā*)—yoked with excellent horses
- रथेन (*rathena*)—with a chariot
- सविताय (*savitāya*)—to bring about welfare
- ईयते (*īyate*)—she comes

Gist

Uṣas, who is rich in wealth, of golden colour, endowed with splendour, of great nature, of attractive form through her rays, and who knows all affairs, rises and comes. Waking those who lie asleep, the shining Uṣas comes with a chariot yoked with excellent horses, to bring about welfare.

English translation

The great and intelligent dawn, variegated with (many-coloured) rays of purple tint, bringing opulence, has come with (her) lustre. the divine Ushas, arousing (the sleepers) proceeds with her well-harnessed car (to distri- bute) felicity.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ वां॒ वहिं॑ष्ठा इ॒ह ते व॑हन्तु॒ रथा॒ अश्वा॑स उ॒षसो॒ व्यु॑ष्टौ ।
इ॒मे हि वां॑ मधु॒पेया॑य॒ सोमा॑ अ॒स्मिन्य॒ज्ञे वृ॑षणा मादयेथाम् ॥ ४ ॥

> *ā vāṃ vahiṣṭhā iha te vahantu rathā aśvāsa uṣaso vyuṣṭau |*
> *ime hi vāṃ madhupeyāya somā asminyajñe vṛṣaṇā mādayethām ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । वां । वहिष्ठाः । इह । ते । वहंतु । रथाः । अश्वासः । उषसः । विउष्टौ ।
> इमे । हि । वां । मधुपेयाय । सोमाः । अस्मिन् । यज्ञे । वृषणा । मादयेथां

> *ā | vāṃ | vahiṣṭhāḥ | iha | te | vahaṃtu | rathāḥ | aśvāsaḥ | uṣasaḥ | viuṣṭau |*
> *ime | hi | vāṃ | madhupeyāya | somāḥ | asmin | yajñe | vṛṣaṇā | mādayethāṃ*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे अश्विनाविह यज्ञे वहिष्ठा वोढृतमास्ते प्रसिद्धा रथा रंहणा गंतारोऽश्वासोऽश्वा नां युवामुषस उषोदेवताया व्युष्टौ व्युच्छनकाल आ वहंतु ।
> समंतान्नयंतु । हि यस्मात्कारणात् हे वृषणा वृषण् कामानां वर्षितार् हे
> अश्विनाविमे सोमा नां युवां मधुपेयाय मधोः सोमस्य पानायास्मिन्यज्ञे मादयेथां । हर्षयेथां ॥

> *he aśvināviha yajñe vahiṣṭhā voḍhṛtamāste prasiddhā rathā raṃhaṇā gaṃtāro 'śvāso 'śvā nāṃ yuvāmuṣasa uṣodevatāyā vyuṣṭau vyucchanakāla ā vahaṃtu |*
> *samaṃtānnayaṃtu | hi yasmātkāraṇāt he vṛṣaṇā vṛṣaṇ kāmānāṃ varṣitār he*
> *aśvināvime somā nāṃ yuvāṃ madhupeyāya madhoḥ somasya pānāyāsminyajñe mādayethāṃ | harṣayethāṃ ‖*

Summary

O Aśvins, here in this sacrifice, those well-known chariot-horses of yours, the best of carriers (वहिष्ठा (*vahiṣṭhā*) = *voḍhṛtamāḥ*) and swift goers (रथा (*rathā*) = *raṃhaṇā gaṃtāraḥ*), are to bring you at the time of the dawning (व्युष्टौ (*vyuṣṭau*) = व्युच्छनकाल (*vyucchanakāla*)) of the deity Uṣas; that is, to lead you here from every side. For (हि (*hi*)) these Soma juices are for your drinking of the honey, the Soma. O showerers (वृषणा (*vṛṣaṇā*) = showerers of desires), delight yourselves in this sacrifice, that is, rejoice.

Word-to-word meaning

- वृषणा (*vṛṣaṇā*)—Aśvin deities, showerers of desires
- इह (*iha*)—to this sacrifice
- वहिष्ठाः (*vahiṣṭhāḥ*)—those that bring you in the highest degree
- ते (*te*)—well-known
- रथाः (*rathāḥ*)—swift-going
- अश्वासः (*aśvāsaḥ*)—horses
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you
- उषसः (*uṣasaḥ*)—of Uṣas
- पुष्टौ (*puṣṭau*)—at the time of rising
- आ वहंतु (*ā vahaṃtu*)—may they bring
- इमे सोमाः (*ime somāḥ*)—these Soma juices
- वां (*vāṃ*)—you
- मधुपेयाय (*madhupeyāya*)—for drinking the honey
- अस्मिन् यज्ञे (*asmin yajñe*)—in this sacrifice
- मादयेथां (*mādayethāṃ*)—may they gladden

Gist

O Aśvin deities, showerers of desires, may the well-known and swift horses, which bear you and bring you to this sacrifice, bring you at the rising of the dawn. May these Soma juices gladden you in this sacrifice, for your drinking of the honey.

English translation

May those robust and active horses bring you, (Ashwins) hither at the breaking of the dawn, and may these Soma juices prepared, showerers (of benefits), for your drinking, exhilarate you at this (our sacrifice).

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अना॑यतो॒ अनि॑बद्धः क॒थायं न्यं॑ङ्ङुत्ता॒नोऽव॑ पद्यते॒ न ।
कया॑ याति स्व॒धया॒ को द॑दर्श दि॒वः स्क॒म्भः समृ॑तः पाति॒ नाकं॑म् ॥ ५ ॥

> *anāyato anibaddhaḥ kathāyaṃ nyaṅṅuttāno 'va padyate na |*
> *kayā yāti svadhayā ko dadarśa divaḥ skambhaḥ samṛtaḥ pāti nākam ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अनायतः । अनिबद्धः । कथा । अयं । न्यज् । उत्तानः । अव । पद्यते । न ।
> कया । याति । स्वधया । कः । ददर्श । दिवः । स्कंभः ! संऋतः । पाति । नाकं ॥ ५ ॥

> *anāyataḥ | anibaddhaḥ | kathā | ayaṃ | nyaj | uttānaḥ | ava | padyate | na |*
> *kayā | yāti | svadhayā | kaḥ | dadarśa | divaḥ | skaṃbhaḥ ! saṃṛtaḥ | pāti | nākaṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> आयतशब्दो दूरवाची । तद्विपरितोऽनायत आसीनः सन्नयं प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानो
> मंडलाभिमानी सूर्यो निबद्धः । केनापि बद्धो न क्रियते । अपि
> चायं सूरो नृज्जुर्वाङ्मुखः सन् केनचित्कथा कथं नाव पद्यते । न हिंस्यते ।
> किंचायमुत्तान ऊर्ध्वमुखत्वेन तिष्ठन् कया स्वधया केन बलेन याति । गच्छति ।
> स्वधाशब्दोऽन्नवाच्यत्र तत्कार्यं बलं लक्षयति । अपि च दिवो द्युलोकस्य स्कंभः
> स्तंभः समृतो नाकेन समवेतः सूर्यो नाकं स्वर्गं पाति । पालयति । को
> ददर्श । तत्त्वतः कः पश्यति । न कोऽपि जानातीत्यर्थः ॥

> *āyataśabdo dūravācī | tadviparito 'nāyata āsīnaḥ sannayaṃ pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamāno maṃḍalābhimānī sūryo nibaddhaḥ | kenāpi baddo na kriyate | api*
> *cāyaṃ sūro nṛjjurvāṅmukhaḥ san kenacitkathā kathaṃ nāva padyate | na hiṃsyate |*
> *kiṃcāyamuttāna ūrdhvamukhatvena tiṣṭhan kayā svadhayā kena balena yāti | gacchati |*
> *svadhāśabdo 'nnavācyatra tatkāryaṃ balaṃ lakṣayati | api ca divo dyulokasya skaṃbhaḥ*
> *staṃbhaḥ samṛto nākena samavetaḥ sūryo nākaṃ svargaṃ pāti | pālayati | ko*
> *dadarśa | tattvataḥ kaḥ paśyati | na ko 'pi jānātītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

The word आयत (*āyata*) means "far"; its opposite अनायत (*anāyata*) is "near": the Sun, the deity of the orb, seen directly as he sits, is अनिबद्धः (*anibaddhaḥ*), bound by no one. Moreover, though this Sun moves with his face turned downward (न्यज् (*nyaj*) = *arvāṅmukhaḥ*), how is he not harmed (नाव पद्यते (*nāva padyate*) = न हिंस्यते (*na hiṃsyate*)) by anyone? Further, standing with his face upward (उत्तानः (*uttānaḥ*)), by what स्वधा (*svadhā*), by what strength, does he go? Here the word स्वधा (*svadhā*) means food and indicates the strength that is its result. And again, the Sun, the pillar (स्कंभः (*skaṃbhaḥ*) = स्तंभः (*staṃbhaḥ*)) of the heavenly world, united with heaven (नाकेन समवेतः (*nākena samavetaḥ*)), protects (पाति (*pāti*) = पालयति (*pālayati*)) heaven (नाकं (*nākaṃ*) = स्वर्गं (*svargaṃ*)). Who has truly seen this? The meaning is that no one knows it.

Word-to-word meaning

- अनायतः (*anāyataḥ*)—one who moves near
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—and this Sun, of the form of a disc
- अनिबद्धः (*anibaddhaḥ*)—has a course that is stopped by no one
- न्यज् (*nyaj*)—even though he moves with face turned downward
- कथा (*kathā*)—how indeed!
- न अव पद्यते (*na ava padyate*)—he is harmed by no one
- उत्तानः (*uttānaḥ*)—being with face turned upward
- कया स्वधया (*kayā svadhayā*)—with what strength
- याति (*yāti*)—he moves
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the heavenly world
- स्कंभः (*skaṃbhaḥ*)—pillar-like
- समृतः (*samṛtaḥ*)—abiding in the atmosphere
- नाकं (*nākaṃ*)—heaven
- पाति (*pāti*)—protects: this matter
- को ददर्श (*ko dadarśa*)—who indeed can truly see it?

Gist

The Sun, who moves near and is of the form of a disc, has a course that no one stops. That, though he moves with face turned downward, he is harmed by no one is a wonder. And who indeed knows the secret of the strength with which he moves, facing upward, and how, as the pillar-like support of the heavenly world and abiding in the atmosphere, he protects heaven?

English translation

This sun, not far removed and unobstructed, whether looking downwards or upwards, is harmed by no one: what is the power by which he travels ? who has (truly)beheld him who, as the collective pillar of heaven. sustains the sky.

Sūkta 15 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sūkta 15. Introduction. An account of the rite called Paryagnikaraṇa.

In the first three Ṛks of this sūkta a part of a rite performed in a sacrifice called Paryagnikaraṇa is described. Paryagnikaraṇa is a rite to be performed in order that the substances offered in the fire (the animal, the cooked rice, the oblation, the ghee and so on) become pure and fit to be accepted by the gods in the sacrifice. When an animal is to be offered, it is first tied to the sacrificial post on the sacrificial altar. After it has been consecrated with ghee and the like, the priest called Āgnīdhra takes a burning brand from the Āhavanīya fire and carries it three times round the animal, clockwise. This rite is done not only in the sacrifice but also in the domestic rites, that is, in the homas performed in houses at marriages and the like; there, to purify the oblation substances such as cooked rice and ghee that are to be offered, fire is kindled with pieces of darbha grass, carried round the oblation substance three times, and then put into the fire.

Here the offering is purified by carrying the fire round it. This is still done in all rites. In the Aśvamedha sacrifice there is a slight difference in this matter: instead of bringing the fire round the animal, the animal itself is made to circumambulate the fire. As the Ṛk एषः भागः पुरो अश्वेन वाजिना पूष्टो भागो नीयते विश्वदेव्यः ॥ (*eṣaḥ bhāgaḥ puro aśvena vājinā pūṣṭo bhāgo nīyate viśvadevyaḥ ‖*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-162-3) says, in the Aśvamedha the horse and the he-goat are the animals; of these the he-goat is led round the fire in front, and behind it the horse. For the first three Ṛks of this sūkta, which explain this Paryagnikaraṇa procedure, the meaning explained in the Aitareya Brāhmaṇa is given here:

पर्यग्नये क्रियामाणायानुब्रूहीत्याहाध्वर्युः (*paryagnaye kriyāmāṇāyānubrūhītyāhādhvaryuḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 6-5).

When the rite called Paryagnikaraṇa is performed in the sacrifice, the priest called Āgnīdhra takes a burning brand from the Āhavanīya fire and, reciting the Ṛk परिवाजपतिः (*parivājapatiḥ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 4-1-3), carries it three times round the animal, clockwise. For this rite the

Adhvaryu addresses the Hotṛ (or the priests of the Hotṛ class) and directs them by the Praiṣa mantra: पर्यग्नये क्रियमाणायानुब्रूहि (*paryagnaye kriyamāṇāyānubrūhi*), "recite the mantras to be recited for the Paryagni rite." Then, accordingly, the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa recites the three Ṛks beginning अग्निर्होता (*agnirhotā*). There is a special point here: although the Adhvaryu directs that the Hotṛ should recite these mantras, the Maitrāvaruṇa recites them with the Hotṛ's permission. This manner of reciting is called Upapraiṣa mantra. In some sacrifices, the Soma and others, the Maitrāvaruṇa himself gives the Praiṣa mantra for the recitation of the Yājyā mantras. As the sign of his authority to give this direction the Maitrāvaruṇa has a staff (daṇḍa). Holding that staff, the Maitrāvaruṇa exercises his authority by directing the various priests in the rites each has to perform. This is stated in the Yajurveda sentence:

क्रीते सोमे मैत्रावरुणाय दंडं प्रयच्छति मैत्रावरुणो हि पुरस्तादृत्विग्भो वाचं विभजति । (*krīte some maitrāvaruṇāya daṃḍaṃ prayacchati maitrāvaruṇo hi purastādṛtvigbho vācaṃ vibhajati* |) (Kṛ. Saṃ. 6-1-4-2).[?444]

The three Ṛks that the Maitrāvaruṇa recites are explained thus:

आग्निर्होता नो अध्यस्त इति तृचमाग्नेयं गायत्रमन्वाह पर्यग्निक्रियमाणे स्वयैवैनं तद्देवतया स्वेन छंदसा समर्धयति । (*āgnirhotā no adhyasta iti tṛcamāgneyaṃ gāyatramanvāha paryagnikriyamāṇe svayaivainaṃ taddevatayā svena chaṃdasā samardhayati* |).

Because the fire is carried round the animal, this rite is called Paryagni. That in this rite the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa should recite the three Ṛks beginning अग्निर्होता (*agnirhotā*) has been stated by the sage Āśvalāyana in the Śrauta Sūtra by the sūtra प्रेषितो मैत्रावरुणोऽग्निर्होता न इति तृचं पर्यग्नयेऽन्वाह (*preṣito maitrāvaruṇo 'gnirhotā na iti tṛcaṃ paryagnaye 'nvāha*). Since the name of Agni stands at the beginning of these three Ṛks, not only is Agni the deity of these mantras, but Gāyatrī, the metre of Agni, is the metre of all three Ṛks. Thus, since Agni is the deity of the mantras and the metre too is Gāyatrī, which is dear to the deity Agni, by reciting mantras furnished with the deity and metre suited to this rite, the prominence of the deity is, as it were, increased.

वाजी सन्परिणीयत इति वाजिनमिव ह्येनं संतं परिणयंति ॥ (*vājī sanpariṇīyata iti vājinamiva hyenaṃ saṃtaṃ pariṇayaṃti* ‖). The word वाजी (*vājī*) means "one who has food" or "one who has motion". Therefore the priests here praise Agni with the word वाजि (*vāji*) and make him go round the animal. Here the animal offered to the gods is the food (the oblation); the three-fold circuit is Agni's motion. Thus the qualities that are the meanings of the word वाजि (*vāji*), having food and having motion, are, as it were, in Agni.

परित्रिविष्ट्यध्वरं यात्यग्नी रथीरिवेत्येष हि रथीरिवाध्वरं परियाति । परि वाजपतिः कविरित्येष हि वाजानां पतिः ॥ (*paritriviṣṭyadhvaraṃ yātyagnī rathīrivetyeṣa hi rathīrivādhvaraṃ pariyāti* | *pari vājapatiḥ kavirityeṣa hi vājānāṃ patiḥ* ‖) (Ai. Brā. 6-5). The sentence in the mantra परित्रिविष्टध्वरं परियात्यग्नी रथीरिव (*paritriviṣṭadhvaraṃ pariyātyagnī rathīriva*) means that in this sacrifice Agni circles swiftly round the animal, as a charioteer seated in a chariot travels swiftly. The sentence परिवाजपतिः कविः (*parivājapatiḥ kaviḥ*) means that this Agni, the far-seeing one (who knows everything), is the lord of food, or the carrier of the oblation suited to Indra and the other gods.

The explanation of the rite-part called Paryagnikaraṇa is ended.

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अग्निर्होतेति दशर्चं पंचमं सूक्तं वामदेवस्यार्षं गायत्रं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । अग्निर्होता दश
> गायत्रमृषिर्भोधदित्याभ्यां सोमकं साहदेव्यमभ्यवदत्पराभ्यामस्याश्विनावायुरयाचतेति ।
> बोधद्यदिति दृचेन सोमकराजा स्तूयत एष नामिति द्वृचेनाश्विन् शिष्टाभिः षड्भिरग्निः स्तूयते ।
> अतस्ता एव
> क्रमेण देवताः ॥ सूक्तविनियोगो लैंगिकः ॥ पशोः पर्यग्निकरणेऽग्निर्होता न
> इत्याद्यस्तृचोऽनुवचनीयः । तथा च सूत्रितु । अग्निर्होता न इति तृचं पर्यग्न्ययेऽन्वाह । आ.
> ३–२ । इति ॥ प्रातरनुवाकेऽप्याग्नेये क्रत् गौयत्रे छंदस्याश्विनशस्त्रे चायं तृचो विनियुक्तः ।
> तथा च सूत्रितं। अग्निर्होता नो अद्वर इति तिस्रः
> आ– ४–१३ । इति ॥

> *agnirhoteti daśarcaṃ paṃcamaṃ sūktaṃ vāmadevasyārṣaṃ gāyatraṃ* |
> *atreyamanukramaṇikā* | *agnirhotā daśa*
> *gāyatramṛṣirbhodhadityābhyāṃ somakaṃ*
> *sāhadevyamabhyavadatparābhyāmasyāśvināvāyurayācateti* |
> *bodhadyaditi dṛcena somakarājā stūyata eṣa nāmiti dvṛcenāśvin*

> *śiṣṭābhiḥ ṣaḍhbhiragniḥ stūyate | atastā eva*
> *krameṇa devatāḥ ‖ sūktaviniyogo laiṃgikaḥ ‖ paśoḥ paryagnikaraṇe 'gnirhotā na*
> *ityādyastṛco 'nuvacanīyaḥ | tathā ca sūtritu | agnirhotā na iti tṛcaṃ*
> *paryagnyaye 'nvāha | ā. 3-2 | iti ‖ prātaranuvāke 'pyāgneye krat*
> *gauyatre chaṃdasyāśvinaśastre cāyaṃ tṛco viniyuktaḥ | tathā ca*
> *sūtritaṃ| agnirhotā no advara iti tisraḥ*
> *ā- 4-13 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta अग्निर्होता (*agnirhotā*) has ten Ṛks and is the fifth sūkta; its seer is Vāmadeva, its metre Gāyatrī. The Anukramaṇikā is quoted: the first six Ṛks are to Agni, the two beginning बोधद्यत् (*bodhadyat*) (Ṛks 7 and 8) praise King Somaka Sāhadevya, the two beginning एष नां (*eṣa nāṃ*) (Ṛks 9 and 10) the Aśvins, and the remaining six Agni; so the deities are those same ones in that order. The use of the sūkta is by indication (लैंगिकः (*laiṃgikaḥ*)). In the Paryagnikaraṇa of the animal the triplet beginning अग्निर्होता नः (*agnirhotā naḥ*) is the verse to be recited (*anuvacanīyaḥ*); so the sūtra: अग्निर्होता न इति तृचं पर्यग्न्ययेऽन्वाह (*agnirhotā na iti tṛcaṃ paryagnyaye 'nvāha*) (Ā. 3-2). This triplet is also used in the Prātaranuvāka, for the Āgneya Kratu in the Gāyatra metre and in the Āśvina Śastra; so the sūtra: अग्निर्होता नो अद्वर इति तिस्रः (*agnirhotā no advara iti tisraḥ*) (Ā. 4-13).?445

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning अग्निर्होता (*agnirhotā*) is the fifth sūkta in the second anuvāka. It has ten Ṛks. Vāmadeva is its seer; the metre is Gāyatrī. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said: अग्निर्होता दश गायत्रमृषिर्भोधत् इत्याभ्यां सोमकं साहदेन्यमभ्यवदत्पराभ्यामस्याश्विनानायुरयाचत (*agnirhotā daśa gāyatramṛṣirbhodhat ityābhyāṃ somakaṃ sāhadenyamabhyavadatparābhyāmasyāśvinānāyurayācata*). In the two Ṛks beginning बोधद्यत् (*bodhadyat*) (Ṛks 7 and 8) there is praise of King Somaka; in the two Ṛks beginning एष नां (*eṣa nāṃ*) (Ṛks 9 and 10) there is praise of the Aśvin deities, and in the remaining Ṛks praise of Agni. Therefore the deities of the respective Ṛks are, in order, those praised in them. The use of the sūkta is by indication. And in the rite called Paryagnikaraṇa, carrying fire round the animal, the three Ṛks beginning अग्निर्होता नः (*agnirhotā naḥ*) are to be recited as the Anuvacanīya mantra, as is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra अग्निर्होता न इति तृचं पर्यग्न्ययेऽन्वाह (*agnirhotā na iti tṛcaṃ paryagnyaye 'nvāha*) (Ā. 3-2). And at the time of reciting the Prātaranuvāka mantras, the three Ṛks beginning अग्निर्होता नः (*agnirhotā naḥ*) are used for the Gāyatrī-metre mantras connected with the Āgneya Kratu and for the recitation of the Āśvina Śastra mantras, as is explained by the sūtra of the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra अग्निर्होता नो अध्वर इति तिस्रः (*agnirhotā no adhvara iti tisraḥ*) (Ā. 4-13).

> सूक्त—१५
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—२ ॥ सूक्त—१५ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—१५, १६ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—१० ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—१–६, अग्निः । ७, ८. सोमकः साहदेव्यः. ९–१०,.
> अश्विनौ ॥
> छंदः—गायत्री ॥

> *sūkta—15*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—2 ‖ sūkta—15 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—15, 16 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—10 ‖*
> *ṛṣiḥ—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—1-6, agniḥ | 7, 8. somakaḥ sāhadevyaḥ. 9-10,.*
> *aśvinau ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—gāyatrī ‖*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒ग्निर्होता॑ नो अ॒ध्व॒रे वा॒जी सन्परि॑ णीयते ।
दे॒वो दे॒वेषु॑ य॒ज्ञिय॑ः ॥ १ ॥

> *agnirhotā no adhvare vājī sanpari ṇīyate |*
> *devo deveṣu yajñiyaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अग्निः । होता । नः । अध्वरे । वाजी । सन् । परि । नीयते ।
> देवः । देवेषु । यज्ञियः ॥ १ ॥

> *agniḥ | hotā | naḥ | adhvare | vājī | san | pari | nīyate |*
> *devaḥ | deveṣu | yajjiyaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> होता देवानामाह्वाता होमनिष्पादको वाग्निर्नोऽस्मदीयेऽध्वरे
> यागे । वाजीत्येतल्लुप्तोपमाकं । वाजी शीघ्रगामिा वोढाश्व इव तथा देवेभ्यो
> हविर्वाहकः सन् परि णेयते । परितः समंतात्पाप्यते । तथा ब्राह्मणं च भवति ।
> वाजी सन्सरि णेयत इति वाजिनमिव ह्येनं संतं परिणयंति । ऐ. ब्रा. २–५ । इति ।
> कीदृशोऽग्निः। देवेषु द्योतमानेस्विंद्रादिषु मध्यें देवो द्योतमानो यज्ञियो यज्ञार्हः ।

> *hotā devānāmāhvātā homaniṣpādako vāgnirno 'smadīye 'dhvare*
> *yāge | vājītyetalluptopamākaṃ | vājī śīghragāmiā voḍhāśva iva tathā devebhyo*
> *havirvāhakaḥ san pari ṇeyate | paritaḥ samaṃtātpāpyate | tathā brāhmaṇaṃ ca bhavati |*
> *vājī sansari ṇeyata iti vājinamiva hyenaṃ saṃtaṃ pariṇayaṃti | ai. brā. 2-5 | iti |*
> *kīdṛśo 'gniḥ| deveṣu dyotamānesviṃdrādiṣu madhyè devo dyotamāno yajjiyo yajñārhaḥ |*

Summary

Agni is the Hotṛ, the caller of the gods, or the accomplisher of the homa, in our sacrifice (अध्वरे (*adhvare*) = यागे (*yāge*)). वाजी (*vājī*) has its simile dropped (लुप्तोपमाकं (*luptopamākaṃ*)): like a swift-going horse that bears a load, so, being the carrier of the oblation to the gods, he is led round (परि णेयते (*pari ṇeyate*)), that is, conducted on every side. So also says a Brāhmaṇa: वाजी सन्सरि णेयत इति वाजिनमिव ह्येनं संतं परिणयंति । (*vājī sansari ṇeyata iti vājinamiva hyenaṃ saṃtaṃ pariṇayaṃti |*) (Ai. Brā. 2-5).[?446]

What kind of Agni is he? Among the shining gods, Indra and the others, he is the shining god, यज्ञियः (*yajjiyaḥ*), worthy of sacrifice.

Word-to-word meaning

- होता (*hotā*)—the accomplisher of the oblation
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among the gods, Indra and the others
- देवः (*devaḥ*)—the shining one
- यज्ञियः (*yajñiyaḥ*)—the one worthy of sacrifice
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- अध्वरे (*adhvare*)—in the sacrifice
- वाजी सन् (*vājī san*)—being the bearer of the oblation like a swift-going horse
- परिणीयते (*pariṇīyate*)—is led around

Gist

Agni, the accomplisher of the oblation, shining among the gods Indra and the others, and worthy of sacrifice, is led around in our sacrifice as the bearer of the oblation to the gods, like a swift-going horse.

English translation

Agni, the invoker (of the gods), like a horse (that bears a burden), is brought to our sacrifice; a deity adorable amongst deities.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

परि॑ त्रिवि॒ष्ट्य॑ध्व॒रं यात्य॒ग्नी र॒थीरि॑व ।
आ दे॒वेषु॒ प्रयो॒ दध॑त् ॥ २ ॥

> *pari triviṣṭyadhvaraṃ yātyagnī rathīriva |*
> *ā deveṣu prayo dadhat ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परि । त्रिविष्टि । अध्वरं । याति । अग्निः । रथीः इव ।
> आ । देवेषु । प्रयः । दधत् ॥ २ ॥

> *pari | triviṣṭi | adhvaraṃ | yāti | agniḥ | rathīḥ iva |*
> *ā | deveṣu | prayaḥ | dadhat ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवेषु द्योतमानेष्विंद्रादिषु । प्रय इत्यन्ननामेदं । प्रयो यजमानैर्दत्तं हवीरूपमन्नमा दधत् आ समंताद्धारयन्नग्निरंगनादिगुणविशिष्टोऽग्निस्त्रिविष्टि त्रिवारं । सवनत्रयेऽपीत्यर्थः । परि परितः समंतादध्वरं यजमानैः
> कृतं यागं याति । गच्छति । परिगमने दृष्टांतः । रथीरिव । रथवान्पुरुषो यथा
> शीघ्रं याति तद्वत् । तथा च ब्राह्मणं । परि त्रिनिष्ट्यध्वरं यात्यग्नी रथीरिवेत्येष हि
> रथीरिवाध्वरं पर्योति । ऐ. ब्रा. २–५ इति ॥

> *deveṣu dyotamāneṣṭviṃdrādiṣu | praya ityannanāmedaṃ | prayo yajamānairdattaṃ havīrūpamannamā dadhat ā samaṃtāddhārayannagniraṃganādiguṇaviśiṣṭo 'gnistriviṣṭi trivāraṃ | savanatraye 'pītyarthaḥ | pari paritaḥ samaṃtādadhvaraṃ yajamānaiḥ*
> *kṛtaṃ yāgaṃ yāti | gacchati | parigamane dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | rathīriva | rathavānpuruṣo yathā*
> *śīghraṃ yāti tadvat | tathā ca brāhmaṇaṃ | pari triniṣṭyadhvaraṃ yātyagnī rathīrivetyeṣa hi*
> *rathīrivādhvaraṃ paryoti | ai. brā. 2-5 iti ‖*

Summary

Among the gods, the shining Indra and the rest, Agni, endowed with qualities such as that of going forward, holds fully the food, the oblation given by the sacrificers; त्रिविष्टि (*triviṣṭi*) means "thrice", that is, at all three pressings. He goes all around the sacrifice performed by the sacrificers, as a man with a chariot goes swiftly; this is the illustration of his going around. The Brāhmaṇa says the same: परि त्रिनिष्ट्यध्वरं यात्यग्नी रथीरिवेत्येष हि रथीरिवाध्वरं पर्योति (*pari triniṣṭyadhvaraṃ yātyagnī rathīrivetyeṣa hi rathīrivādhvaraṃ paryoti*) (Ai. Brā. 2-5).[?447]

Word-to-word meaning

- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among (for) the gods Indra and the others

- प्रयः (*prayaḥ*)—oblations
- आ दधत् (*ā dadhat*)—bearing fully
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- त्रिविष्टि (*triviṣṭi*)—at all three times of the sacrifice
- परि (*pari*)—around
- अध्वरं (*adhvaraṃ*)—the sacrifice
- रथीः इव (*rathīḥ iva*)—as a charioteer comes swiftly
- याति (*yāti*)—approaches

Gist

Agni, who bears the oblations for the gods Indra and the others, comes swiftly at all three times of the sacrifice, like a charioteer coming swiftly, and is ready in the sacrifice.

English translation

Agni, thrice (a day), comes to our sacrifice like a charioteer, bearing the sacrificial food to the gods.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

परि॒ वाज॑पतिः क॒विर॒ग्निर्ह॒व्यान्य॑क्रमीत् ।
दध॒द्रत्ना॑नि दा॒शुषे॑ ॥ ३ ॥

> *pari vājapatiḥ kaviragnirhavyānyakramīt |*
> *dadhadratnāni dāśuṣe ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परि । वाजपतिः । कविः । अग्निः । हव्यानि । अक्रमीत्. ।
> दधत् । रत्नानि । दाशुषे ॥ ३ ॥

> *pari | vājapatiḥ | kaviḥ | agniḥ | havyāni | akramīt. |*
> *dadhat | ratnāni | dāśuṣe ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वाजपतिर्वाजानामन्नानां पतिः पालकः । परि वाजपतिः कविरित्येष हि वाजानां पतिः । ऐ.
> ब्रा. २–५ । इति ब्राह्मणं । कविः क्रांतदर्शि मेधावी ना दाशुषे
> हविर्दत्तवते यजमानाय रत्नानि रमणीयानि धनानि दधत् प्रयच्छन्नग्निर्हव्यानि
> हवींषि पर्यक्रमीत् । परितः क्रामति । व्याप्नोति ॥

> *vājapatirvājānāmannānāṃ patiḥ pālakaḥ | pari vājapatiḥ kavirityeṣa hi vājānāṃ patiḥ | ai. brā. 2-5 | iti brāhmaṇaṃ | kaviḥ krāṃtadarśi medhāvī nā dāśuṣe*
> *havirdattavate yajamānāya ratnāni ramaṇīyāni dhanāni dadhat prayacchannagnirhavyāni*
> *havīṃṣi paryakramīt | paritaḥ krāmati | vyāpnoti ||*

Summary

वाजपतिः (*vājapatiḥ*) is the lord and protector of वाज (*vāja*), foods. The Brāhmaṇa says: परि वाजपतिः कविरित्येष हि वाजानां पतिः (*pari vājapatiḥ kavirityeṣa hi vājānāṃ patiḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 2-5). कविः (*kaviḥ*) is the far-seeing, the wise. Agni, giving delightful riches to the sacrificer who has given the oblation, has gone around the oblations; पर्यक्रमीत् (*paryakramīt*) means he strides around, he pervades.

Word-to-word meaning

- वाजपतिः (*vājapatiḥ*)—the protector of foods
- कविः (*kaviḥ*)—the far-seeing
- दाशुषे (*dāśuṣe*)—to the one who offers the oblation
- रत्नानि (*ratnāni*)—delightful riches
- दधत् (*dadhat*)—the giver
- अग्निः (*agniḥ*)—Agni
- हव्यानि (*havyāni*)—the oblations
- परि अक्रमीत् (*pari akramīt*)—has surrounded, pervaded and stands

Gist

Agni, the lord and protector of foods, the wise, the giver of delightful riches to the sacrificer who offers the oblation, stands surrounding and pervading the oblations.

English translation

The sage, Agni, the lord of food, has encompassed the oblation, giving precious things to the donor.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं यः सृञ्ज॑ये पु॒रो दै॑ववा॒ते स॑मि॒ध्यते॑ ।
द्यु॒माँ अ॑मि॒त्रदम्भ॑नः ॥ ४ ॥

> *ayaṃ yaḥ sṛñjaye puro daivavāte samidhyate |*
> *dyumā~ amitradambhanaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । यः । सृंजये । पुरः । दैववाते । संइध्यते ।
> द्युमान् । अमित्र्यदंभनः ॥ ४ ॥

> *ayaṃ | yaḥ | sṛṃjaye | puraḥ | daivavāte | saṃidhyate |*
> *dyumān | amitryadaṃbhanaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यः प्रसिद्धोऽयं प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानोऽग्निर्दैववाते देववातस्य
> पुत्रे सृंजये । सृंजयो नाम कश्चित्सोमयाची । तस्मिन्निमित्तभूते सति तद्यागार्थमित्यर्थः ।
> सृंजयस्य यष्टत्वं तैत्तिरीया आमनंति । वासिष्ठो ह सात्यहव्यो देवभागं पप्रच्छ
> यत्सृंजयान्बहुयाजिनोऽयीयजः । तै. स. ६–६–२–२।
> इति । पुरः पूर्वस्यां दिशि स्थितायामुत्तरवेद्यां समिध्यते । सम्यग्गीप्यते । अमित्रदंभनः
> शत्रूणां हिंसकः सोऽग्निर्द्युमान् दीप्तिमान् भवतीति शेषः ॥

> *yaḥ prasiddho 'yaṃ pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamāno 'gnirdaivavāte devavātasya*
> *putre sṛṃjaye | sṛṃjayo nāma kaścitsomayācī | tasminnimittabhūte sati tadyāgārthamityarthaḥ | sṛṃjayasya yaṣṭatvaṃ taittirīyā āmanaṃti | vāsiṣṭho ha sātyahavyo devabhāgaṃ papraccha yatsṛṃjayānbahuyājino 'yīyajaḥ | tai. sa. 6-6-2-2|*

> *iti | puraḥ pūrvasyāṃ diśi sthitāyāmuttaravedyāṃ samidhyate | samyaggīpyate | amitradaṃbhanaḥ śatrūṇāṃ hiṃsakaḥ so 'gnirdyumān dīptimān bhavatīti śeṣaḥ ‖*

Summary

This well-known Agni, perceived before our eyes, is kindled for Sṛñjaya, son of Devavāta; Sṛñjaya was a Soma-sacrificer, and Agni is kindled because of him, for his sacrifice. The Taittirīyas record Sṛñjaya's sacrificing: वासिष्ठो ह सात्यहव्यो देवभागं पप्रच्छ यत्सृंजयान्बहुयाजिनोऽयीयजः (*vāsiṣṭho ha sātyahavyo devabhāgaṃ papraccha yatsṛṃjayānbahuyājino 'yīyajaḥ*) (Tai. Saṃ. 6-6-2-2). पुरः (*puraḥ*): on the northern altar situated in the eastern direction he is well kindled. He, the destroyer of foes, becomes द्युमान् (*dyumān*), radiant; "becomes" is to be supplied.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—the well-known
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—the visible Agni
- दैववाते (*daivavāte*)—of the son of Devavāta
- सृंजये (*sṛṃjaye*)—for the sacrifice of one named Sṛñjaya, as he appeared visibly before
- पुरः (*puraḥ*)—on the northern altar in front
- समिध्यते (*samidhyate*)—is kindled
- अमित्रदंभनः (*amitradaṃbhanaḥ*)—that same destroyer of foes
- द्युमान् (*dyumān*)—shines, endowed with brilliance

Gist

The well-known, visible Agni is kindled on the northern altar in front, as he appeared visibly before for the sacrifice of Sṛñjaya, son of Devavāta; and that same destroyer of foes shines, endowed with brilliance.

English translation

Radiant in this Agni, the subduer of foes, who is kindled on the (altar) of the east as (he was kindled) for Srinjaya, the son of Devavata.

Special Topics

Sṛñjaye: the commentator says that Sṛñjaya was a Soma-sacrificer, the son of Devavāta, and that Agni blazed well in the sacrifice he performed. The name of this Sṛñjaya is mentioned in this Ṛk and also in the Ṛk

स सृंजयाय तुर्वशं परादाद्व्रजीवतो दैववाताय शिक्षन् । (*sa sṛṃjayāya turvaśaṃ parādādvrajīvato daivavātāya śikṣan |*)

(Ṛ. Saṃ. 6-27-7).

Here it is said that Indra subjected the king Turvaśa to the king Sṛñjaya, son of Devavāta. Sṛñjaya is to be understood as king of the people of that name (the Sṛñjayas). The defeat of these Sṛñjayas in battle is mentioned in the Yajurveda:

वासिष्ठो ह सात्यहव्यो देवभागं पप्रच्छ यत्संजयान्बहुयाजिनोयीयजो यज्ञे यज्ञं प्रत्यतिष्ठिपा यज्ञपताविति सहोवाच यज्ञपताविति सत्याद्वै संजयाः पराबभूवुरिति होवाच ॥ (*vāsiṣṭho ha sātyahavyo devabhāgaṃ papraccha yatsaṃjayānbahuyājinoyīyajo yajñe yajñaṃ pratyatiṣṭhipā yajñapatāviti sahovāca yajñapatāviti satyādvai saṃjayāḥ parābabhūvuriti hovāca ‖*)

(Śai. Saṃ. 6-6-2-2, 3)?448

The matter of these Sṛñjayas will be explained in the sixth Maṇḍala. See also the account of Somaka, a king of this same line, given in the 7th Ṛk of this same sūkta.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अस्य॑ घा वी॒र ईव॑तो॒ऽग्नेरी॑शीत॒ मर्त्य॑ः ।
ति॒ग्मज॑म्भस्य मी॒ळ्हुष॑ः ॥ ५ ॥

> *asya ghā vīra īvato 'gnerīśīta martyaḥ |*
> *tigmajambhasya mīḷhuṣaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अस्य । घ । वीरः । ईवतः । अग्नेः । ईशीत । मर्त्यः ।
> तिग्मृजंभस्य । मीळ्हुषः ॥ ५ ॥

> *asya | gha | vīraḥ | īvataḥ | agneḥ | īśīta | martyaḥ |*
> *tigmṛjaṃbhasya | mīḷhuṣaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वीरः स्तुता विक्रांतो मर्त्यो मरणधर्मा यजमानस्तिग्मजंभस्य तीक्ष्णतेजसो
> माळ्हुषोऽभिलषितफलानां सेक्तुरीवतो गमनवतोऽस्याग्नेरीशीत ।
> ईश्वरो भवेत् । घेति पादपूरणः । एतेन यजमान आत्माभीष्टफलं कारयितुं
> समर्थो भवतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *vīraḥ stutā vikrāṃto martyo maraṇadharmā yajamānastigmajaṃbhasya*
> *tīkṣṇatejaso māḷhuṣo 'bhilaṣitaphalānāṃ sekturīvato gamanavato*
> *'syāgnerīśīta |*
> *īśvaro bhavet | gheti pādapūraṇaḥ | etena yajamāna ātmābhīṣṭaphalaṃ*
> *kārayituṃ*
> *samartho bhavatītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

The वीरः (*vīraḥ*), the praising, valiant mortal, that is the sacrificer subject to death, may become master of this Agni, who is तिग्मजंभस्य (*tigmajaṃbhasya*) of sharp splendour, मीळ्हुषः (*mīḷhuṣaḥ*) the sprinkler (showerer) of the fruits desired, and ईवतः (*īvataḥ*) endowed with movement. ईशीत (*īśīta*) means "may be master". घ (*gha*) is a mere verse-filler. By this the sacrificer becomes able to bring about the fruit he desires.[?449]

Word-to-word meaning

- वीरः (*vīraḥ*)—one who has power in praise
- मर्त्यः (*martyaḥ*)—the human sacrificer
- तिग्मजंभस्य (*tigmajaṃbhasya*)—of him who has sharp splendour
- मीळ्हुषः (*mīḷhuṣaḥ*)—the giver of the desired fruit
- ईवतः (*īvataḥ*)—of him whose nature is movement
- अस्य अग्नेः (*asya agneḥ*)—of this same Agni
- ईशीत (*īśīta*)—may be master

Gist

May the human sacrificer, who has extraordinary power in praise, be master of this same Agni, who has sharp splendour, gives the desired fruit and is of the nature of movement.

English translation

May the mortal who is strenuous (in worship) acquire authority over this Agni, the sharp-rayed, the showerer (of benefits).

Ṛk 6

Samhitā-pāṭha

तमर्व॑न्त॒ं न सा॑न॒सिम॑रु॒षं न दि॒वः शिशु॑म् ।
म॒र्मृ॒ज्यन्ते॑ दि॒वेदि॑वे ॥ ६ ॥

> *tamarvantaṃ na sānasimaruṣaṃ na divaḥ śiśum |*
> *marmṛjyante divedive ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । अर्वंतं । न । सानसिं । अरुषं । न । दिवः । शिशुं ।
> मर्मृज्यंते । दिवेदिवे ॥ ६ ॥

> *taṃ | arvaṃtaṃ | na | sānasiṃ | aruṣaṃ | na | divaḥ | śiśuṃ |*
> *marmṛjyaṃte | divedive ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यजमाना अर्वंतं न शीघ्रगामिनमश्वमिव सानसिं संभजनीयं दिवः शिशुं
> न द्युलोकस्य पुत्रभूतं सूर्यमिवारुषमारोचमानं तमग्निं दिवे दिवे प्रतिदिनं मर्मृज्यंते । भृशं परिचरणं कुर्वंति ॥

> *yajamānā arvaṃtaṃ na śīghragāminamaśvamiva sānasiṃ saṃbhajanīyaṃ divaḥ śiśuṃ*
> *na dyulokasya putrabhūtaṃ sūryamivāruṣamārocamānaṃ tamagniṃ dive dive pratidinaṃ marmṛjyaṃte | bhṛśaṃ paricaraṇaṃ kurvaṃti ‖*

Summary

The sacrificers daily, every day, worship intensely that Agni, who is like a swift-going horse, सानसिं (*sānasiṃ*) worthy of being served, and अरुषं (*aruṣaṃ*) shining, like the sun, the son of the heavenly world. मर्मृज्यंते (*marmṛjyaṃte*) means they attend on him greatly.

Word-to-word meaning

- अर्वंतं न (*arvaṃtaṃ na*)—who is like a swift-going horse
- सानसिं (*sānasiṃ*)—the venerable
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—of the firmament
- शिशुं न (*śiśuṃ na*)—like the son, the sun
- अरुषं (*aruṣaṃ*)—of attractive colour
- तं (*taṃ*)—that Agni
- दिवे दिवे (*dive dive*)—every day
- मर्मृज्यंते (*marmṛjyaṃte*)—(the priests and others) attend on greatly

Gist

The priests and others daily attend greatly on Agni, who is like a swift-going horse, venerable, and of attractive colour like the sun, the son of the firmament.

English translation

They diligently worship him daily who is like a horse (to convey oblations), who is liberal and resplendent as the son of heaven, (the sun).

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

बोध॒द्यन्मा॒ हरि॑भ्यां कुमा॒रः सा॑हदे॒व्यः ।
अच्छा॒ न हू॒त उद॑रम् ॥ ७ ॥

> *bodhadyanmā haribhyāṃ kumāraḥ sāhadevyaḥ |*
> *acchā na hūta udaram ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> बोधत् । यत् । मा । हरिभ्यां । कुमारः । साहदेव्यः ।
> अच्छ । न । हूतः । उत् । अरं ॥ ७ ॥

> *bodhat | yat | mā | haribhyāṃ | kumāraḥ | sāhadevyaḥ |*
> *accha | na | hūtaḥ | ut | araṃ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> साहदेव्यः सहदेवनाम्नो राज्यः पुत्रः कुमारः सोमकाभिधो राजा
> हरिभ्यामश्वाभ्यामश्वा दातुं मा मां यद्यदा बोधत् । बोधयामासेमौ
> तवाश्वाविति । तदाहमच्छाभिमुख्येन कुमारेण हूतः सन् नोदरं । तावश्वावलब्धान
> निर्गतवानस्मि ॥

> *sāhadevyaḥ sahadevanānno rājyaḥ putraḥ kumāraḥ somakābhidho rājā*
> *haribhyāmaśvābhyāmaśvā dātuṃ mā māṃ yadyadā bodhat |*
> *bodhayāmāsemau*
> *tavāśvāviti | tadāhamacchābhimukhyena kumāreṇa hūtaḥ san nodaraṃ*
> *| tāvaśvāvalabdhāna nirgatavānasmi ‖*

Summary

Sāhadevya is the son of the king named Sahadeva, the prince (kumāra), the king called Somaka. When he made me aware (bodhat) that "these two horses are yours", that is, when he pointed out the two horses (harī) to give to me, I was called (hūta) towards him (accha). I did not go away from there without receiving those two horses.

Word-to-word meaning

- साहदेव्यः (*sāhadevyaḥ*)—the son of the king named Sahadeva
- कुमारः (*kumāraḥ*)—the prince, who bears the name Somaka
- हरिभ्यां (*haribhyāṃ*)—having come with two horses
- मा (*mā*)—me
- यत् (*yat*)—when

- बोधत् (*bodhat*)—when he pointed out and said (that these belong to you)
- अच्छ (*accha*)—facing him
- हूतः (*hūtaḥ*)—having been called
- न उत् अरं (*na ut araṃ*)—I did not return without getting them

Gist

The prince, the son of the king named Sahadeva and bearing the name Somaka, came with two horses, called me and said, "These two are yours", pointing me out for them. Then I did not return without receiving them.

English translation

When the prince, the son of Sahadéva, promised (to present) me with two horses, I withdrew not when called before him.

Special Topics

Sāhadevya Kumāra—the king named Somaka, son of one named Sahadeva. It is to be understood that he was a king of the people called Sṛñjayas. The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa says that two seers, Parvata and Nārada, were his priests:

एतमु हैव प्रोवाच तुरः काषवेयो जनमेजयाय पारिक्षिताय्केतमु हैव प्रोचतुः पर्वतनारदौ साङ्ज्र्यायाय बभ्रवे दैवावृधाय भीमाय वैदर्भाय नग्नजिते गांधारायैतमु हैव प्रोवाचाग्निः सनश्रुतायारिंदमाय क्रतुविदे जानकाय एतमु हैव प्रोवाच वसिष्ठ सुदासे पैजवनाय ते ह ते सर्व एव महज्ज्ग्मुरेतं भक्तं भक्षयित्वा सर्वे हैव महाराजा आसुरादित्य इव स्म श्रियां प्रतिष्ठितास्तपंति सर्वाभ्यो दिग्भो बलिमावहंतः । (*etamu haiva provāca turaḥ kāṣaveyo janamejayāya pārikṣitāykètamu haiva procatuḥ parvatanāradau sārṅjyāyāya babhrave daivāvṛdhāya bhīmāya vaidarbhāya nagnajite gāṃdhārāyaitamu haiva provācāgniḥ sanaśrutāyāriṃdamāya kratuvide jānakāya etamu haiva provāca vasiṣṭha sudāse paijavanāya te ha te sarva eva mahajjagmuretaṃ bhaktaṃ bhakṣayitvā sarvè haiva mahārājā āsurāditya iva sma śriyāṃ pratiṣṭhitāstapaṃti sarvābhyo digbho balimāvahaṃtaḥ |*) (Ai. Brā. 35-36)

In speaking of certain special matters (traditions handed down) concerning kings' drinking of Soma at the sacrifice, the names of some kings are mentioned here. Among them the name of King

Somaka and the names of his priests Parvata and Nārada are stated. It is thus: on the subject of the Soma-draught, the great seer Tura, son of Kavaṣa, told it to one named Janamejaya, son of Parīkṣit. This is one tradition. This matter the two seers Parvata and Nārada told to the king named Somaka, son of Sahadeva. That Somaka told it to another named Sahadeva of the Sṛñjaya line; that Sahadeva to Babhru of the same line; Babhru to Daivāvṛdha; Daivāvṛdha to Bhīma; Bhīma to Vaidarbha; Vaidarbha to Nagnajit; Nagnajit to Gāndhāra. This is the second tradition.

In the same way the great seer Agni told it to Sanaśruta; Sanaśruta to Arindama; Arindama to Kratuvid; Kratuvid to Jānaka. This is the third tradition. Likewise the great seer Vasiṣṭha told it to Sudāsa, and Sudāsa to Paijavana. It is said here that all the men from Tura down to Paijavana followed this tradition and attained high station.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒त त्या य॑ज॒ता हरी॑ कुमा॒रात्सा॑हदे॒व्यात् ।
प्रय॑ता स॒द्य आ द॑दे ॥ ८ ॥

> *uta tyā yajatā harī kumārātsāhadevyāt |*
> *prayatā sadya ā dade ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उत । त्या । यजता । हरी इति । कुमारात् । साह्यदेव्यात् ।
> प्रयता । सद्यः । आ । ददे ॥ ८ ॥

> *uta | tyā | yajatā | harī iti | kumārāt | sāhyadevyāt |*
> *prayatā | sadyaḥ | ā | dade ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उतापि च साहदेव्यात्सहदेवस्य पुत्रात्कुमारात्सोमकाद्राज्ञो यजता
> पूजनीयौ प्रयता प्रयत् त्या त्यौ तौ प्रसिद्धौ हरी अश्वा सद्यो ऋस्मिन्निने तेना.
> हूतस्तस्मिन्नेव दिन आ ददे । आदत्तवानस्मि । मंत्रद्रष्टा ऋषिर्बोधदित्यग्वयेन
> कुमारमश्वेप्सयाभ्युपगम्याश्वावेतस्माल्लब्ध्वा प्रीतोऽभवदित्यर्थः ॥

> *utāpi ca sāhadevyātsahadevasya putrātkumārātsomakādrājño yajatā*
> *pūjanīyau prayatā prayat tyā tyau tau prasiddhau harī aśvā sadyo ṛsminnine tenā.*
> *hūtastasminneva dina ā dade | ādattavānasmi | maṃtradraṣṭā ṛṣirbodhadityagvayena*
> *kumāramaśvepsayābhyupagamyāśvāvetasmāllabdvā prīto 'bhavadityarthaḥ ||*

Summary

"Uta" means "and also". From the prince Somaka, the king, son of Sahadeva (Sāhadevya), those two well-known horses (hari), worthy of worship (yajatā) and trained (prayatā), I took (ā dade) on that very day (sadyaḥ), the day on which I was called. The seer, the mantra-seer, construing "bodhat" with this: having approached the prince out of desire for horses and having obtained the two horses from him, he became pleased. This is the meaning.

Word-to-word meaning

- उत (*uta*)—and
- साहदेव्यात् (*sāhadevyāt*)—from the son of Sahadeva
- कुमारात् (*kumārāt*)—from the prince named Somaka
- यजता (*yajatā*)—worthy of worship
- प्रयता (*prayatā*)—trained
- त्या (*tyā*)—well-known
- हरी (*harī*)—the two horses
- सद्यः (*sadyaḥ*)—on the very day he had me brought
- आ ददे (*ā dade*)—I accepted

Gist

From the prince, the son of Sahadeva and named Somaka, I received, on the very day he had me brought, the two horses, worthy of worship, trained and well known.

English translation

But immediately accepted those two excellent and well-trained horses from the prince, the son of Sahadeva.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒ष वां॑ देवावश्विना कुमा॒रः सा॑हदे॒व्यः ।
दी॒र्घायु॑रस्तु॒ सोम॑कः ॥ ९ ॥

> *eṣa vāṃ devāvaśvinā kumāraḥ sāhadevyaḥ |*
> *dīrghāyurastu somakaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एषः । नां । देवौ । अश्विना । कुमारः । साहसदेव्यः ।
> दीर्घआयुः । अस्तु । सोमकः ॥ ९ ॥

> *eṣaḥ | nāṃ | devau | aśvinā | kumāraḥ | sāhasadevyaḥ |*
> *dīrghaāyuḥ | astu | somakaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> देवौ द्योतमानौ हे आश्विनौ नां युवां तर्पकः साहदेव्यः सहदेवस्य
> पुत्रः कुमारः सोमकः सोमकाभिधान एष राजा दीर्घायुरस्तु । शतायुष्को
> भवतु । एतमु हैव प्रोचतुः पर्वतनारदौ सोमकायेत्यादिना सर्वे हैव
> महाराजा आसुः। ऐ. ब्रा. ७–३४। इत्यनेन ब्राह्मणेन सोमकस्यराजत्वं स्पष्टीकृतं॥

> *devau dyotamānau he āśvinau nāṃ yuvāṃ tarpakaḥ sāhadevyaḥ*
> *sahadevasya*
> *putraḥ kumāraḥ somakaḥ somakābhidhāna eṣa rājā dīrghāyurastu |*
> *śatāyuṣko*
> *bhavatu | etamu haiva procatuḥ parvatanāradau somakāyetyādinā sarve*

> *haiva*
> *mahārājā āsuḥ| ai. brā. 7-34| ityanena brāhmaṇena somakasyarājatvaṃ spaṣṭīkṛtaṃ||*

Summary

O divine (shining) Aśvins, this king Somaka, the prince, son of Sahadeva, who is your gratifier (nāṃ = yuvām tarpakaḥ), bearing the name Somaka, may he be long-lived, that is, may he live a hundred years. By the Brāhmaṇa beginning एतमु हैव प्रोचतुः पर्वतनारदौ सोमकाय (*etamu haiva procatuḥ parvatanāradau somakāya*) and continuing सर्वे हैव महाराजा आसुः (*sarve haiva mahārājā āsuḥ*) (Ai. Brā. 7-34), the kingship of Somaka is made clear.

Word-to-word meaning

- देवौ (*devau*)—shining
- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—O Aśvin deities
- वां (*vāṃ*)—one who gratifies you
- साहदेव्यः (*sāhadevyaḥ*)—son of Sahadeva
- कुमारः (*kumāraḥ*)—the prince
- सोमकः (*somakaḥ*)—
- (सोमकः (*somakaḥ*) continued) bearing the name Somaka
- एषः (*eṣaḥ*)—this king
- दीर्घायुः (*dīrghāyuḥ*)—possessed of a full life
- अस्तु (*astu*)—may he be

Gist

O shining Aśvin deities, may this king, who gratifies you, the son of Sahadeva, the prince, bearing the name Somaka, be possessed of a full life.

English translation

Divinc Ashwins, may this prince, Somaka, the son of Sahadeva, your (worshipper), enjoy long life.

Special Topics

Somaka—the matter of the king named Somaka, son of Sahadeva, mentioned in the 8th, 9th and 10th ṛks of this sūkta, has been explained in the 7th ṛk of this sūkta. It may be understood by looking there.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तं यु॒वं दे॑वावश्विना कुमा॒रं सा॑हदे॒व्यम् ।
दी॒र्घायु॑षं कृणोतन ॥ १० ॥

> *taṃ yuvaṃ devāvaśvinā kumāraṃ sāhadevyam |*
> *dīrghāyuṣaṃ kṛṇotana ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । युवं । देवौ । अश्विना । कुमारं । साह्यदेव्यं ।
> दीर्घआयुषं । कृणोतन ॥ १० ॥

> *taṃ | yuvaṃ | devau | aśvinā | kumāraṃ | sāhyadevyaṃ |*
> *dīrghaāyuṣaṃ | kṛṇotana ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे देवावश्विना द्योतमानावश्विन् युवं युवां साहदेव्यं सहदेवस्य
> पुत्रं कुमारं सोमकाख्यं राजानं दीर्घायुषं शतायुष्कं कृणोःतन ।
> कुरुतं । अनेन द्वचेनास्य कुमारस्य दीर्घमायुरश्विनावृषिरयाचतेत्यर्थः ॥

> *he devāvaśvinā dyotamānāvaśvin yuvaṃ yuvāṃ sāhadevyaṃ sahadevasya*
> *putraṃ kumāraṃ somakākhyaṃ rājānaṃ dīrghāyuṣaṃ śatāyuṣkaṃ kṛṇoḥtana |*
> *kurutaṃ | anena dvacenāsya kumārasya dīrghamāyuraśvināvṛṣirayācatetyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

O divine, shining Aśvins, you two make the son of Sahadeva, the prince, the king named Somaka, long-lived, that is, of a hundred years' life. By this ṛk the seer asks the Aśvins for a long life for this prince. This is the meaning.

Word-to-word meaning

- देवौ (*devau*)—shining
- अश्विना (*aśvinā*)—O Aśvin deities
- युवं (*yuvaṃ*)—you
- तं (*taṃ*)—the well-known
- साहदेव्यं (*sāhadevyaṃ*)—son of Sahadeva
- कुमारं (*kumāraṃ*)—the prince bearing the name Somaka
- दीर्घायुषं (*dīrghāyuṣaṃ*)—as one possessed of a full life
- कृणोतन (*kṛṇotana*)—make

Gist

O shining Aśvin deities, make the well-known prince, the son of Sahadeva, bearing the name Somaka, one possessed of a full life.

English translation

Divine Ashvins, do you two make the prince, the son of Sahadeva-long-lived.

Sūkta 16 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> आ सत्यो यात्वित्येकविंशत्यृचं षष्ठं सूक्तं त्रैष्टुभमैंद्रं । आत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । आ सत्यः सैकैंद्रमिति । तत्रैंद्रमित्युक्तत्वादग्न्यधिकारो निवृत्त इत्यवगम्यते॥ चतुर्विंशेऽहनि माध्यंदिनसवने मैत्रावरुणशस्त्र इदं द्वितीयमहीनसूक्तं।
> तथा च सूत्रितं । आ सत्यो यात्वित्यहीनसूक्तं द्वितीयं मैत्रावरुणः । आ. ७–४ ।
> इति ॥ समूळ्हे दशरात्रे नवमेऽहनि निष्केवल्यशस्त्र इदं सूक्तं । तथा च सूत्रितं ।
> आ सत्यो यात्वहं भुवं तत्त इंद्रियमिति निष्केवल्यं । आ. ८–७ । इति ॥

> *ā satyo yātvityekaviṃśatyṛcaṃ ṣaṣṭhaṃ sūktaṃ traiṣṭubhamaiṃdraṃ | ātreyamanukramaṇikā | ā satyaḥ saikaiṃdramiti | tatraiṃdramityuktatvādagnyadhikāro nivṛtta ityavagamyate‖ caturviṃśe 'hani mādhyaṃdinasavane maitrāvaruṇaśastra idaṃ dvitīyamahīnasūktaṃ|*
> *tathā ca sūtritaṃ | ā satyo yātvityahīnasūktaṃ dvitīyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ | ā. 7-4 |*
> *iti ‖ samūḷhe daśarātre navame 'hani niṣkevalyaśastra idaṃ sūktaṃ | tathā ca sūtritaṃ |*
> *ā satyo yātvahaṃ bhuvaṃ tatta iṃdriyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ | ā. 8-7 | iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta आ सत्यो यातु (*ā satyo yātu*) has twenty-one ṛks and is the sixth sūkta; it is in Triṣṭubh metre and addressed to Indra. The Anukramaṇikā (of the Ātreya) says आ सत्यः सैकैंद्रं (*ā satyaḥ saikaiṃdraṃ*). Since "aindra" is stated there, it is understood that the Agni section has ended. On the twenty-fourth day, at the midday pressing (mādhyandina-savana), in the Maitrāvaruṇa's śastra, this is the second Ahīna-sūkta. So it is stated in the sūtra आ सत्यो यात्वित्यहीनसूक्तं द्वितीयं मैत्रावरुणः (*ā satyo yātvityahīnasūktaṃ dvitīyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ*) (Ā. Sū. 7-4). In the Samūḍha ten-night rite, on the ninth day, in the Niṣkevalya-śastra, this sūkta is used. So it is stated: आ सत्यो यात्वहं भुवं तत्त इंद्रियमिति निष्केवल्यं (*ā satyo yātvahaṃ bhuvaṃ tatta iṃdriyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ*) (Ā. Sū. 8-7).

Anuvāda (Kannada): This sūkta आ सत्यो यातु (*ā satyo yātu*) is the sixth sūkta in the second anuvāka; it has twenty-one ṛks. Its seer is Vāmadeva; the deity Indra; the metre Triṣṭubh. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said आ सत्यः सैकैंद्रं (*ā satyaḥ saikaiṃdraṃ*). Since "aindra" is said here, it becomes evident that the sūktas with Agni as deity have ended. On the twenty-fourth day of the sacrifice, at the midday pressing, among the śastra mantras to be recited by the priest called Maitrāvaruṇa, this sūkta is to be recited as the second Ahīna-sūkta; this is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra आ सत्यो यातित्यहीनसूक्तं द्वितीयं मैत्रावरुणः (*ā satyo yātityahīnasūktaṃ dvitīyaṃ maitrāvaruṇaḥ*) (Ā. 7-4). And in the ten-night rite called Samūḍha, the use of this sūkta for the recitation of the Niṣkevalya-śastra mantras on the ninth day is explained by the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in the sūtra आ सत्यो यात्वहं भुवं तत्त इंद्रियमिति निष्केवल्यं (*ā satyo yātvahaṃ bhuvaṃ tatta iṃdriyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ*) (Ā. 8-7).

> सूक्त–१६
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—२ ॥ सूक्त—१६
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—१७, १८, १९, २० ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—२१ ॥
> ऋषि:—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—इंद्रः ॥
> छंदः—त्रिष्टप् ॥

> *sūkta-16*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—2 ‖ sūkta—16*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—17, 18, 19, 20 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—21 ‖*
> *ṛṣi:—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—iṃdraḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—triṣṭap ‖*

Sūkta 16. Maṇḍala 4; Anuvāka 2; Sūkta 16. Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 5; Vargas 17, 18, 19, 20. Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 21. Seer: Vāmadeva. Deity: Indra. Metre: Triṣṭubh.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ स॒त्यो या॑तु म॒घवाँ॑ ऋजी॒षी द्रव॑न्त्वस्य॒ हर॑य॒
उप॑ नः ।
तस्मा॒ इदन्ध॑ः सुषुमा सु॒दक्ष॑मि॒हाभि॑पि॒त्वं क॑रते गृ
णा॒नः ॥ १ ॥

> *ā satyo yātu maghavā~ ṛjīṣī dravantvasya haraya upa naḥ |*
> *tasmā idandhaḥ suṣumā sudakṣamihābhipitvaṃ karate gṛṇānaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । सत्यः । यातु । मघ्वान् । ऋजीषी । द्रवंतु । अस्य । हरयः । उप । नः ।
> तस्मै । इत् । अंधः । सुसुम । सुदक्षं । इह । अभिपित्वं । करते । गृणानः ॥ १ ॥

> *ā | satyaḥ | yātu | maghvān | ṛjīṣī | dravaṃtu | asya | harayaḥ | upa | naḥ |*
> *tasmai | it | aṃdhaḥ | susuma | sudakṣaṃ | iha | abhipitvaṃ | karate | gṛṇānaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ऋजीषी । ऋजीषशब्देन निष्पिष्टो विगतसारः सोमोऽभिधीयते । तद्वान्
> सत्यः सत्यवान्मघवान्थनवानिंद्रो नोऽस्माकमुप समीप आ यातु । आगच्छतु । किंच
> अस्येंद्रस्य हरयोऽश्वा नोऽस्माकमुप समीपे द्रवंतु । आगच्छंतु । वयं यजमाना इहास्मिन्यज्ञे
> तस्मा इंद्राय सुदक्षं शोभनबलं । सारोपेतमित्यर्थः ।
> इदिदं प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानमंधोऽन्नरूपं सोमं सुषुम। अभिषुतं कुर्याम । गृणानोऽस्माभिः
> स्तूयमान इंद्रोऽभिपित्वमस्मदभिमतप्राप्तिं करते करोतु॥

> *ṛjīṣī | ṛjīṣaśabdena niṣpiṣṭo vigatasāraḥ somo 'bhidhīyate | tadvān*
> *satyaḥ satyavānmaghavānthanavāniṃdro no 'smākamupa samīpa ā yātu | āgacchatu | kiṃca*
> *asyeṃdrasya harayo 'śvā no 'smākamupa samīpe dravaṃtu | āgacchaṃtu | vayaṃ yajamānā ihāsminyajñe tasmā iṃdrāya sudakṣaṃ śobhanabalaṃ | sāropetamityarthaḥ |*

> *ididaṃ pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamānamaṃdho 'nnarūpaṃ somaṃ suṣuma| abhiṣutaṃ kuryāma | gṛṇāno 'smābhiḥ stūyamāna iṃdro 'bhipitvamasmadabhimataprāptiṃ karate karotu||*

Summary

"Ṛjīṣī": by the word ṛjīṣa is meant Soma that has been pressed and whose essence is gone. Possessed of it, true (satya), wealthy (maghavān, "possessing wealth") Indra, may he come (ā yātu) near us. Further, may this Indra's bay horses (harayaḥ) run, that is, come, near us. We sacrificers, here (iha) in this sacrifice, for that Indra, would press (suṣumā) this very food (andhas), the Soma visible before us, of good strength (sudakṣa), that is, endowed with essence. May Indra, being praised (gṛṇāna) by us, bring about the attainment of what we desire (abhipitva).

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋजीषी (*ṛjīṣī*)—one who has Soma of the nature of ṛjīṣa
- सत्यः (*satyaḥ*)—the truthful
- मघवान् (*maghavān*)—Indra, the wealthy
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- उप (*upa*)—near
- आ यातु (*ā yātu*)—may he come and join
- अस्य (*asya*)—his

ई इंद्रन (*ī iṃdrana*)—of this Indra: his horses, may they run to us bringing him. In this sacrifice, for that Indra, let us press and prepare the Soma-food, of excellent vigour and ready here. May Indra, praised by us, bring about the attainment of our desired object.

- हरयः (*harayaḥ*)—the horses of this Indra
- द्रवंतु (*dravaṃtu*)—let them run to us (bringing him)
- इह (*iha*)—in this sacrifice
- तस्मै (*tasmai*)—addressed to that Indra
- सुदक्षं (*sudakṣaṃ*)—of excellent vigour
- इत् (*it*)—and ready here
- अंधः (*aṃdhaḥ*)—the food in the form of Soma

- सुषुम (*suṣuma*)—let us press and prepare
- गृणानः (*gṛṇānaḥ*)—Indra, praised by us
- अभिपित्वं (*abhipitvaṃ*)—the attainment of our desired object
- करते (*karate*)—let him bring about

Gist

May Indra, who has the Soma of the rjīṣa kind, who is truthful and wealthy, come and join us near. May this Indra's horses bring him near to us. In this sacrifice let us press and prepare the Soma-food that is addressed to Indra alone, of excellent vigour and ready here. May Indra, praised by us, bring about the fulfilment of our desired object.

English translation

May the truthful Maghavan, the accepter of the spiritless Soma, come to us ; may his horses hasten to us : to him we offer this sacrifice, the very potent beverage : may he grant the fulfilment of our desires.

Special Topics

Ṛjīṣī: ऋजीषी—ऋजीषशब्देन निष्पिष्टो विगतसारः सोमोऽभिधीयते । तद्वान् इंद्रः ॥ (*ṛjīṣī—ṛjīṣaśabdena niṣpiṣṭo vigatasāraḥ somo 'bhidhīyate | tadvān iṃdraḥ ||*) Ṛjīṣa means the husks of the Soma plant left over after the juice has been taken by crushing with stones; it is like the husk remaining after the juice of sugar-cane is taken. In the sacrifice there are rites in which juice is taken from the Soma plants and prepared at the three times: morning, midday and evening, called the morning pressing, the midday pressing and the third pressing. In the morning and midday pressings freshly brought Soma plants are crushed and the juice taken. In the third pressing, that is in the evening, fresh Soma plants are not used. The husks left after pressing in the morning and midday are soaked in water and pressed well once more, and with the little juice that comes, three kinds of āśira materials, milk, curds and flour, are mixed and drunk. In the present Ṛk, because Soma mixed with āśira materials is offered to Indra at the time of the third pressing, and because that Soma juice is pressed out from Soma plants already drained, called ṛjīṣa, Indra is described by the word ṛjīṣī.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अव॑ स्य शू॒राध्वं॑नो॒ नान्ते॒ऽस्मिन्नो॑ अ॒द्य सव॑ने म॒न्दध्यै॑ ।
शंसा॑त्यु॒क्थमु॒शनें॑व वे॒धाश्चिं॑कि॒तुषें॑ असु॒र्या॑य॒ मन्मं॑ ॥ २ ॥

> *ava sya śūrādhvano nānte 'sminno adya savane mandadhyai |*
> *śaṃsātyukthamuśaneva vedhāścikituṣe asuryāya manma ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अव । स्य । शूर । अध्वनः । न । अंते । अस्मिन् । नः । अद्य । सवने । मंदध्यै ।
> शंसाति । उक्धं । उशनाइव । वेधाः । चिकितुषे । आसुर्याय । मन्म ॥ २ ॥

> *ava | sya | śūra | adhvanaḥ | na | aṃte | asmin | naḥ | adya | savane | maṃdadhyai |*
> *śaṃsāti | ukdhaṃ | uśanāiva | vedhāḥ | cikituṣe | āsuryāya | manma ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे शूर शत्रूणामभिभवसमर्थेंद्र अद्येदानीमस्मिन् सवने माध्यंदिनाख्ये
> मंदध्यै त्वां मादयितुं नोऽस्मानव स्य । विमुंच । तत्र दृष्टांतः । अध्वनो
> गंतव्यस्य मार्गस्यांते समीपे नाश्वान्मनुष्या यथा मुंचंति तद्वत् । उशनेव
> काव्य इव वेधाः शंसिता यजमानो हे इंद्र चिकितुषे सर्वं जानतेऽसुर्यायासुराणां हिंसकाय
> तुभ्यं मन्म मननीयमुक्थं शस्त्ररूपं स्तोत्रं शंसाति
> शंसनं करोति ॥

> *he śūra śatrūṇāmabhibhavasamartheṃdra adyedānīmasmin savane mādhyaṃdinākhye*
> *maṃdadhyai tvāṃ mādayituṃ no 'smānava sya | vimuṃca | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | adhvano*
> *gaṃtavyasya mārgasyāṃte samīpe nāśvānmanuṣyā yathā muṃcaṃti tadvat | uśaneva*
> *kāvya iva vedhāḥ śaṃsitā yajamāno he iṃdra cikituṣe sarvaṃ jānate*
> *'suryāyāsurāṇāṃ hiṃsakāya tubhyaṃ manma mananīyamukthaṃ śastrarūpaṃ stotraṃ śaṃsāti*
> *śaṃsanaṃ karoti ||*

Summary

O hero, Indra, able to overcome enemies, today at this midday pressing, to gladden you, release us (अव स्य (*ava sya*), "set free"). The illustration: as men let their horses loose near the end of the road to be travelled. Like Uśanas, i.e. Kāvya, the worshipper, the praiser (वेधाः (*vedhāḥ*)), recites to you, O Indra, who know all and are the destroyer of the Asuras, a prayer to be meditated upon (मन्म (*manma*)), a hymn in the form of an uktha-recitation (śastra).

Word-to-word meaning

- शूर (*śūra*)—O valiant Indra
- अद्य (*adya*)—today
- अस्मिन् सवने (*asmin savane*)—at this midday pressing
- मंदधै (*maṃdadhai*)—to satisfy you
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- अध्वनः (*adhvanaḥ*)—of the road, the means of travel
- अंते न (*aṃte na*)—as men leave horses free near it
- अव स्य (*ava sya*)—release us, leaving us free
- उशनेव (*uśaneva*)—like Uśanas
- मेधाः (*medhāḥ*)—the worshipper who praises you?[450]
- चिकितुषे (*cikituṣe*)—to you, the all-knowing
- असुराय (*asurāya*)—to you, the destroyer of enemies, to offer?[451]
- मन्म (*manma*)—venerable
- उकथं (*ukathaṃ*)—the hymn in the form of a śastra?[452]
- शंसति (*śaṃsati*)—recites

Gist

O valiant Indra, today at this midday pressing, to satisfy you, as a horse is let loose freely on the road, not tied, so do not make us bound but release us free. The worshipper who praises you exceedingly, like the sage Uśanas, recites to you, the all-knowing destroyer of enemies, a venerable hymn in the form of a śastra, to offer to you.

English translation

Hero, Indra, set us free to-day to give you exhilaration at this sacrifice, as (they let loose a horse) at the end of the road: may the worshipper, like Ushanas, repeat an acceptable prayer to you, the knower (of all things), the destroyer of the Asuras.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क॒विर्न नि॒ण्यं वि॒दथा॑नि॒ साध॒न्वृषा॒ यत्सेकं॑ विपिपा॒नो अर्चा॑त् ।
दि॒व इ॒त्था जी॑जनत्स॒प्त का॒रूनह्ना॑ चिच्चक्रुर्व॒युना॑ गृ॒णन्त॑ः ॥ ३ ॥

> *kavirna niṇyaṃ vidathāni sādhanvṛṣā yatsekaṃ vipipāno arcāt |*
> *diva itthā jījanatsapta kārūnahnā ciccakrurvayunā gṛṇantaḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कविः । न । निण्यं । विदथानि । साधन् । वृषा । यत् । सेकं । विपिपानः । अर्चात् ।
> दिवः । इत्था । जीजनत् । सप्त । कारून् । अह्ना । चित् । चक्रुः । वयुना । गृणंतः॥

> *kaviḥ | na | niṇyaṃ | vidathāni | sādhan | vṛṣā | yat | sekaṃ | vipipānaḥ | arcāt |*
> *divaḥ | itthā | jījanat | sapta | kārūn | ahnā | cit | cakruḥ | vayunā | gṛṇaṃtaḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> कविर्मेधावी निण्यं न । निण्यमित्यंतर्हितनामैतत् । अंतर्हितं गूढमर्थमिव विदथानि वेदनीयानि कार्यजातानि साधन् साधयन् वृषा कामानां वर्षितेंद्रो यद्यदा सेकं सेचनीयं सोमं विपिसानोऽत्यर्थं पिबन् अर्जात्
> विशेषेणार्चति । सोमपाने श्रद्धां करोतीत्यर्थः । तदानीं दिवोऽमुष्माल्लोकादित्सा सत्यमेव सप्त सप्तसंख्याकान् कारून्रश्मीन् जीजनत् । अजीजनत् ।
> जनयति । गृणंतः स्तूयमाना रश्मयो वयुना वयुनानि मनुष्याणां ज्ञानान्यह्ना चित् दिवसेनापि चक्रुः । कृतवंतः ॥

> *kavirmedhāvī niṇyaṃ na | niṇyamityaṃtarhitanāmaitat | aṃtarhitaṃ gūḍhamarthamiva vidathāni vedanīyāni kāryajātāni sādhan sādhayan vṛṣā kāmānāṃ varṣiteṃdro yadyadā sekaṃ secanīyaṃ somaṃ vipisāno 'tyarthaṃ piban arjāt*
> *viśeṣeṇārcati | somapāne śraddhāṃ karotītyarthaḥ | tadānīṃ divo 'muṣmāllokāditsā satyameva sapta saptasaṃkhyākān kārūnraśmīn jījanat | ajījanat |*
> *janayati | gṛṇaṃtaḥ stūyamānā raśmayo vayunā vayunāni manuṣyāṇāṃ jñānānyahnā cit divasenāpi cakruḥ | kṛtavaṃtaḥ ||*

Summary

The sage (kavi), the intelligent one, like something hidden (निण्यमित्यंतर्हितनामैतत् (*niṇyamityaṃtarhitanāmaitat*): niṇya is a name for "hidden"), a concealed matter; Indra, the showerer of desires, accomplishing the things to be known, i.e. the works to be done, when, drinking excessively the pressed Soma, he honours it specially, that is, shows faith in drinking Soma, then from that heaven he truly generates the seven rays (kārūn). The rays, being praised, by day also produce the perceptions (वयुना (*vayunā*)) of men.

Word-to-word meaning

- कविः (*kaviḥ*)—the sage of far-reaching insight
- निण्यं न (*niṇyaṃ na*)—as one knows a hidden secret truth
- विदथानि (*vidathāni*)—the duties to be performed
- साधयन् (*sādhayan*)—accomplishing
- वृषा (*vṛṣā*)—Indra, the granter of desired objects
- यत् (*yat*)—when

- सेकं (*sekaṃ*)—the pressed Soma
- विपिपानः (*vipipānaḥ*)—drinking abundantly
- अर्चात् (*arcāt*)—shows faith in drinking Soma (then)
- दिवः (*divaḥ*)—from heaven
- इत्या (*ityā*)—being true?453
- सप्त कारून् (*sapta kārūn*)—the seven rays
- जीजनत् (*jījanat*)—creates
- गृणंतः (*gṛṇaṃtaḥ*)—the rays that praise Indra's power, or the praiseworthy rays
- वयुना (*vayunā*)—objects for human knowledge
- अह्ना चित् (*ahnā cit*)—in the daytime
- चक्रुः (*cakruḥ*)—produce (they bring all things within man's understanding)

Gist

Indra, who accomplishes the duties to be performed, as a sage knows a hidden secret truth, and who grants desired objects, when he drinks the pressed Soma abundantly and shows exceeding faith in the drinking, then creates from heaven the seven rays of the nature of truth. These most praiseworthy rays in the daytime make all things perceptible to human knowledge.

English translation

Like a sage (knowing) what is hidden, and fulfilling sacred rites, so the showerer (of benefits), quaffing copiously the effused (libation), exults (in the draught), and this generates the seven efficient (rays) from heaven, which, being glorified, have made (manifest) the objects of (human) per- ception by day,

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्व१॒॑र्यद्वेदि॑ सु॒दृशी॑कम॒र्कैर्महि॒ ज्योती॑ रुरु॒चुर्यद्ध॒ वस्तो॑ः ।
अ॒न्धा तमां॑सि॒ दुधि॑ता वि॒चक्षे॒ नृभ्यं॑श्चका॒र नृत॑मो अ॒भिष्टौ॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *svaryadvedi sudṛśīkamarkairmahi jyotī rurucuryaddha vastoḥ |*
> *andhā tamāṃsi dudhitā vicakṣe nṛbhyaścakāra nṛtamo abhiṣṭau ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्वः । यत् । वेदि । सुदृशीकं । अर्कैः । महि । ज्योतिः । रुरुचुः । यत् । ह । वस्तोः ।
> अंधा । तमांसि । दुधिता । विचक्षे । नृभ्यः । चकार । नृतमः । अभिष्टौ ॥ ४ ॥

> *svaḥ | yat | vedi | sudṛśīkaṃ | arkaiḥ | mahi | jyotiḥ | rurucuḥ | yat | ha | vastoḥ |*
> *aṃdhā | tamāṃsi | dudhitā | vicakṣe | nṛbhyaḥ | cakāra | nṛtamaḥ | abhiṣṭau ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> युद्ध यदा खलु महि महत्प्रभूतं ज्योतिस्तेजोरूपं यत्स्वयो
> द्युलोकोर्के रश्मिभिः सुदृशीकं सुष्टु दर्शनीयं वेदि । अवेदि । ज्ञायते ।
> तदानीं देवास्तस्मिन् स्वर्गे वस्तोर्निवासार्थं रुरुचुः । दीप्तियुक्ता बभूवुः ।
> नृतमो नेतृतमः सूर्योऽभिष्टावभ्यागमने नृभ्यो नृणां विचक्षे विशेषेण
> दर्शनायांधांधकाररूपाणि निविडानि तमांसि दुधिता दुधितानि नाशितानि चकार ।
> कृतवान् ॥

> *yuddha yadā khalu mahi mahatprabhūtaṃ jyotistejorūpaṃ yatsvayo*
> *dyulokorkè raśmibhiḥ sudṛśīkaṃ suṣṭu darśanīyaṃ vedi | avedi | jñāyate |*
> *tadānīṃ devāstasmin svarge vastornivāsārthaṃ rurucuḥ | dīptiyuktā babhūvuḥ |*
> *nṛtamo netṛtamaḥ sūryo 'bhiṣṭāvabhyāgamane nṛbhyo nṛṇāṃ vicakṣe*

> *viśeṣeṇa*
> *darśanāyāṃdhāṃdhakārarūpāṇi niviḍāni tamāṃsi dudhitā dudhitāni*
> *nāśitāni cakāra* |
> *kṛtavān* ||

Summary

When the great, abundant light of the nature of radiance, the heaven (स्वः (*svaḥ*)), is known as well visible by the rays, then the gods shine, becoming radiant for dwelling in that heaven. The best leader, the Sun, on his approach, for men's clear seeing, destroys the dense glooms, of the form of blinding darkness.

Word-to-word meaning

- यद्ध (*yaddha*)—when
- महि (*mahi*)—abundant
- ज्योतिः (*jyotiḥ*)—of the nature of radiance
- यत् स्वः (*yat svaḥ*)—which heaven
- अर्कैः (*arkaiḥ*)—by the rays
- सुदृशीकं (*sudṛśīkaṃ*)—well illumined
- वेदि (*vedi*)—is known (then all the gods also)
- वस्तोः (*vastoḥ*)—in accord with their dwelling in heaven
- रुरुचुः (*rurucuḥ*)—shone
- नृतमः (*nṛtamaḥ*)—the Sun, guide of all
- अभिष्टौ (*abhiṣṭau*)—at the time of his coming
- नृभ्यः (*nṛbhyaḥ*)—for men
- विचक्षे (*vicakṣe*)—for clear seeing
- अंधा तमांसि (*aṃdhā tamāṃsi*)—the dense darkness
- दुधिता (*dudhitā*)—so as to be uprooted
- चकार (*cakāra*)—made

Gist

When heaven, of vast form and of the nature of radiance, is known as brightly illumined by the rays, then all the gods dwelling in heaven became radiant, each according to his dwelling in heaven. The Sun, the leader of all, at the time of his coming, uprooted the dense darkness so that men might see clearly.

English translation

When the vast luminous heaven manifested by the rays (of light) is displayed, then are (the deities) resplendent according to (their heavenly) abode : the chief of leaders, (Indra), in his approach has scattered the thick glooms so that men may see.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

व॒व॒क्ष इन्द्रो॒ अमि॑तमृजी॒ष्यु॒१॑भे आ प॑प्रौ॒ रोद॑सी महि॒त्वा ।
अत॑श्चिदस्य महि॒मा वि रे॑च्य॒भि यो विश्वा॒ भुव॑ना ब॒भूव॑ ॥ ५ ॥

> *vavakṣa indro amitamṛjīṣyubhe ā paprau rodasī mahitvā |*
> *ataścidasya mahimā vi recyabhi yo viśvā bhuvanā babhūva ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ववक्षे । इंद्रः । अमितं । ऋजीषी । उभे इति । आ । पप्रौ । रोदसी इति । महित्वा ।
> अतः । चित् । अस्य । महिमा । वि । रेचि । अभि । यः । विश्वा । भुवना । बभूव ॥ ५ ॥

> *vavakṣe | iṃdraḥ | amitaṃ | ṛjīṣī | ubhe iti | ā | paprau | rodasī iti | mahitvā |*
> *ataḥ | cit | asya | mahimā | vi | reci | abhi | yaḥ | viśvā | bhuvanā | babhūva ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> ऋजीषी । ऋजीषशब्देन निष्पिष्टो विगतसारः सोमोऽभिधीयते । तद्वानिंद्रः परमैश्वर्ययुक्तोऽमितमियत्तारहितं महिमानं ववक्षे । उवाह । किंच महित्वा महत्वेन स्वेन महिम्नोभे रोदसी उभे द्यावापृथिव्यावा पप्रौ । समंतादपूरयत् । य इंद्रो विश्वा भुवना सर्वाणि भुवनान्यभि बभूव । तिरश्चकार । अतश्चिदेभ्योऽपि विश्वेभ्यो भुवनेभ्योऽस्येंद्रस्य महिमा वि रेचि । अतिरिरिचे। अधिको बभूवेत्यर्थः ॥

> *ṛjīṣī | ṛjīṣaśabdena niṣpiṣṭo vigatasāraḥ somo 'bhidhīyate |*
> *tadvāniṃdraḥ paramaiśvaryayukto 'mitamiyattārahitaṃ mahimānaṃ*
> *vavakṣe | uvāha | kiṃca*
> *mahitvā mahatvena svena mahimnobhe rodasī ubhe dyāvāpṛthivyāvā*
> *paprau |*
> *samaṃtādapūrayat | ya iṃdro viśvā bhuvanā sarvāṇi bhuvanānyabhi*
> *babhūva | tiraścakāra | ataścidebhyo 'pi viśvebhyo bhuvanebhyo*
> *'syeṃdrasya mahimā vi reci | atiririce|*
> *adhiko babhūvetyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

Ṛjīṣī: by the word ṛjīṣa is meant Soma that is crushed and drained of its essence; Indra, possessed of it and of supreme lordship, bore (ववक्षे (*vavakṣe*), उवाह (*uvāha*)) greatness without measure. Moreover, by his own greatness he filled on all sides both heaven and earth. Indra, who overpowered all the worlds, whose greatness therefore exceeded (वि रेचि (*vi reci*)) even all these worlds, became superior.

Word-to-word meaning

- ऋजीषी (*ṛjīṣī*)—who has drunk the Soma of the ṛjīṣa kind
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—the lord Indra
- अमितं (*amitaṃ*)—immeasurable greatness
- ववक्षे (*vavakṣe*)—obtained
- महित्वा (*mahitvā*)—by his majesty
- उभे रोदसी (*ubhe rodasī*)—both heaven and earth
- आ पप्रौ (*ā paprau*)—pervaded completely
- यः (*yaḥ*)—that same Indra who
- विश्वा भुवना (*viśvā bhuvanā*)—all the worlds
- अभि बभूव (*abhi babhūva*)—brought under his control
- अतश्चित् (*ataścit*)—more than all the worlds
- अस्य (*asya*)—of Indra
- महिमा (*mahimā*)—greatness
- वि रेचि (*vi reci*)—grew exceedingly

Gist

Indra, who has drunk the Soma of the ṛjīṣa kind and is the lord, obtained immeasurable greatness. By his majesty he completely pervaded both heaven and earth. That same Indra brought all the worlds under his control; Indra's greatness grew greater than all the worlds.

English translation

Indra, the accepter of the stale Soma, sustains infinite greatness, and has filled both heaven and earth by his magnitude : therefore has the vast-nes of him who has surpassed all the regions, exceeded (the world).

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

विश्वा॑नि श॒क्रो नर्या॑णि वि॒द्वान॒पो रि॑रेच॒ सखि॑भि॒र्निका॑मैः ।
अश्मा॑नं चि॒द्ये बि॑भि॒दुर्वचो॑भिर्व्र॒जं गोम॑न्तमु॒शिजो॒ वि व॑व्रुः ॥ ६ ॥

> *viśvāni śakro naryāṇi vidvānapo rireca sakhibhirnikāmaiḥ |*
> *aśmānaṃ cidye bibhidurvacobhirvrajaṃ gomantamuśijo vi vavruḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> विश्वानि । शक्रः । नर्याणि । विद्वान् । अपः । रिरेच । सखिभिः । निकामैः ।
> अश्मानं । चित् । ये । बिभिदुः । वचःभिः । व्रजं । गोमंतं । उशिजः । वि ।
> ववुरिति ववुः ॥ ६ ॥

> *viśvāni | śakraḥ | naryāṇi | vidvān | apaḥ | rireca | sakhibhiḥ | nikāmaiḥ |*
> *aśmānaṃ | cit | ye | bibhiduḥ | vacaḥbhiḥ | vrajaṃ | gomaṃtaṃ | uśijaḥ | vi |*
> *vavuriti vavuḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वानि समस्तानि नर्याणि मनुष्याणां हितानि वृष्टादीनि कार्याणि विद्वान्
> जानन् शक्रः समर्थ इंद्रो निकामैर्निकामयमानेभ्यः सखिभिर्मित्रभूतेभ्यो
> मरुद्भ्यः ॥ व्यत्ययेन चतुर्थ्यर्थे तृतीया ॥ अपो वृष्टिलक्षणान्युदकानि रिरेच ।
> रिक्तीचकार । इंद्रः सस्यादिफलसिद्ध्यर्थं मेघस्थान्युदकानि मरुद्भ्यो दत्तनानित्यर्थः ।
> यद्वा । निकामैर्निकामयमानैः सखिभिर्मरुद्भिः सहितः सन् अपो नभसः
> सकाशात् । आप इत्यंतरिक्षनामैतत् ॥ अत्र विभक्ति व्यत्ययः ॥ रिरेच । व्यतिरिक्तो
> बभूव । ये मरुतो वचोभिर्वाग्रूपैर्ध्वनिभिरश्मानं चित् पर्वतमपि मेघं
> ना । अश्मेति मेघनामैतत् । बिभिदुः । अभैत्तुः । उशिजः कामयमानास्ते मरुतो
> गोमंतं गोभिरुपेतु व्रजमंगिरसां संबंधि गोस्थानं वि ववुः । आच्छादयामासुः ॥

> *viśvāni samastāni naryāṇi manuṣyāṇāṃ hitāni vṛṣṭādīni kāryāṇi vidvān*
> *jānan śakraḥ samartha iṃdro nikāmairnikāmayamānebhyaḥ sakhibhirmitrabhūtebhyo*
> *marudbhyaḥ ‖ vyatyayena caturthyarthe tṛtīyā ‖ apo vṛṣṭilakṣaṇānyudakāni rireca |*
> *riktīcakāra | iṃdraḥ sasyādiphalasiddhyarthaṃ meghasthānyudakāni marudbhyo dattanānityarthaḥ | yadvā | nikāmairnikāmayamānaiḥ sakhibhirmaruddhiḥ sahitaḥ san apo nabhasaḥ*
> *sakāśāt | āpa ityaṃtarikṣanāmaitat ‖ atra vibhakti vyatyayaḥ ‖ rireca | vyatirikto*
> *babhūva | ye maruto vacobhirvāgrūpairdhvanibhiraśmānaṃ cit parvatamapi meghaṃ*
> *nā | aśmeti meghanāmaitat | bibhiduḥ | abhaittuḥ | uśijaḥ kāmayamānāste maruto*
> *gomaṃtaṃ gobhirupetu vrajamaṃgirasāṃ saṃbaṃdhi gosthānaṃ vi vavuḥ | ācchādayāmāsuḥ ‖*

Summary

Indra, who is शक्रः (*śakraḥ*) (capable) and knows all things beneficial to men, such as rain and the like (नर्याणि (*naryāṇi*) = "good for men"), रिरेच (*rireca*) ("emptied out", "released") the waters, i.e. the waters of rain, for the Maruts, who are his friends (सखिभिः (*sakhibhiḥ*)) and ardently desire them (निकामैः (*nikāmaiḥ*)). The instrumental is used by exchange of case for the dative. The sense is that Indra gave the waters stored in the cloud to the Maruts so that crops and the like might ripen.

Or else: accompanied by the Maruts, his friends who ardently desire, Indra released the waters from the sky (*āpaḥ* is a name of the atmosphere; a change of case is assumed here), and so became distinguished (व्यतिरिक्तो बभूव (*vyatirikto babhūva*)).

The Maruts who split even the अश्मानं (*aśmānaṃ*) (mountain, i.e. the cloud; अश्म (*aśma*) is a name of the cloud) with their वचोभिः (*vacobhiḥ*) (voice-like sounds) are उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*), desirous; they covered (वि वव्रुः (*vi vavuḥ*)) the व्रजं (*vrajaṃ*), the cow-pen belonging to the Aṅgirases, which is full of cattle.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वानि (*viśvāni*)—all
- नर्याणि (*naryāṇi*)—acts beneficial to men, such as the sprinkling of rain
- विद्वान् (*vidvān*)—the knowing
- शक्रः (*śakraḥ*)—and capable Indra
- निकामैः (*nikāmaiḥ*)—to those of loving mind
- सखिभिः (*sakhibhiḥ*)—and friendly Maruts
- अपः (*apaḥ*)—the waters in the form of rain
- रिरेच (*rireca*)—he offered
- ये (*ye*)—which Maruts
- वचोभिः (*vacobhiḥ*)—with sounds in the form of speech
- अश्मानं चित् (*aśmānaṃ cit*)—the clouds that are like mountains
- बिभिदुः (*bibhiduḥ*)—split
- उशिजः (*uśijaḥ*)—the Maruts who wished to fulfil their duty
- गोमंतं (*gomaṃtaṃ*)—filled with cows
- व्रजं (*vrajaṃ*)—the cow-pen
- वि वव्रुः (*vi vavruḥ*)—caused to open

Gist

Indra, who knows all the acts beneficial to men, such as the sprinkling of rain, and is the lord, offered the waters in the form of rain to the Maruts, who are of loving mind and are his friends. The same Maruts split even the clouds that are like mountains with their sounds in the form of speech. The Maruts, wishing to fulfil their duty, caused the cow-pen filled with cows to open for the Aṅgirases.

English translation

Knowing all things profitable for men, Sakra has, with his willing friends (the Maruts), sent forth the waters, for they, with (loud) shouts, divided the clouds, and, desiring (to fulfil) their office, set open the pasturage of the cows (of the Angirasas).

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒पो वृ॒त्रं व॑व्रि॒वांसं॒ परा॑ह॒न्प्राव॑त्ते॒ वज्रं॑ पृथि॒वी सचे॑ताः ।
प्रार्णां॑सि समु॒द्रिया॑ण्यैनो॒ः पति॒र्भव॒ञ्छव॑सा शूर धृष्णो ॥ ७ ॥

> *apo vṛtraṃ vavrivāṃsaṃ parāhanprāvatte vajraṃ pṛthivī sacetāḥ |*
> *prārṇāṃsi samudriyāṇyainoḥ patirbhavañchavasā śūra dhṛṣṇo ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अपः । वृत्रं । वव्रिवांसं । परा । अहन् । प्र । आवत् । ते । वज्रं । पृथिवी ।
> सचेताः ।
> प्र । अर्णांसि । समुद्रियाणि । ऐनोः । पतिः । भवन् । शवसा । शूर । धृष्णो इति ॥

> *apaḥ | vṛtraṃ | vavrivāṃsaṃ | parā | ahan | pra | āvat | te | vajraṃ | pṛthivī |*
> *sacetāḥ |*
> *pra | arṇāṃsi | samudriyāṇi | ainoḥ | patiḥ | bhavan | śavasā | śūra | dhṛṣṇo iti ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र प्रावत् राक्षसादिभ्यः प्रकर्षेण लोकान् पालयितृ ते त्वदीयं
> वज्रमपो वृष्टिलक्षणान्युदकानि वव्रिवांसमावरकं वृत्रं मेघं पराहन् । प्रकर्षेण प्रेरयति स्म !
> पृथिवी भूमिः सचेताश्चेतनावती । त्वया संगता बभूव ।

> *he iṃdra prāvat rākṣasādibhyaḥ prakarṣeṇa lokān pālayitṛ te tvadīyaṃ vajramapo vṛṣṭilakṣaṇānyudakāni vavrivāṃsamāvarakaṃ vṛtraṃ meghaṃ parāhan | prakarṣeṇa prerayati sma ! pṛthivī bhūmiḥ sacetāścetanāvatī | tvayā saṃgatā babhūva |*

> धृष्णो धर्षणशील हे शूर विक्रांतेंद्र त्वं शवसा बलेन पतिर्भवन् लोकानां
> पालकः सन् समुद्रियाणि समुद्रसंबंधीन्यर्णांसि नभसि स्थितान्त्युदकानि प्रैणोः ।
> प्रेरकोऽभूः ॥

> *dhṛṣṇo dharṣaṇaśīla he śūra vikrāṃteṃdra tvaṃ śavasā balena patirbhavan lokānāṃ*
> *pālakaḥ san samudriyāṇi samudrasaṃbaṃdhīnyarṇāṃsi nabhasi sthitāntyudakāni praiṇoḥ |*
> *prerako 'bhūḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, you who protect the worlds from Rākṣasas and the like (प्रावत् (*prāvat*)), your thunderbolt struck down (पराहन् (*parāhan*): it drove away vigorously) Vṛtra, the cloud that covers (वव्रिवांसं (*vavrivāṃsaṃ*)) the waters in the form of rain. The earth, सचेताः (*sacetāḥ*) (endowed with consciousness), became united with you.

O bold (धृष्णो (*dhṛṣṇo*), ever ready to overcome) and heroic Indra, being by your might (शवसा (*śavasā*)) the lord and protector of the worlds, you impelled (प्रैणोः (*praiṇoḥ*), you became the impeller of) the ocean-related waters (समुद्रियाणि (*samudriyāṇi*)), the waters that stand in the sky.

Word-to-word meaning

- प्रावत् (*prāvat*)—O Indra, protector from the harm of Rākṣasas and the like
- ते (*te*)—your
- वज्रं (*vajraṃ*)—the thunderbolt

- अपः (*apaḥ*)—the waters of rain
- वव्रिवांसं (*vanrivāṃsaṃ*)—that hides
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—the cloud
- पराहन् (*parāhan*)—splits (thereafter)
- पृथिवी (*pṛthivī*)—the earth
- सचेताः (*sacetāḥ*)—endowed with consciousness (joins you)
- धृष्टो (*dhṛṣṭo*)—O Indra, destroyer of enemies
- शूर (*śūra*)—and valiant
- शवसा (*śavasā*)—with your strength
- पतिः (*patiḥ*)—as protector of the world
- भवन् (*bhavan*)—being
- समुद्रियाणि (*samudriyāṇi*)—those connected with the sky
- अर्णांसि (*arṇāṃsi*)—the waters
- प्र एनोः (*pra enoḥ*)—impel (them) to pour down

Gist

O Indra, who protect from the harm of Rākṣasas and the like, your thunderbolt splits the cloud that hides the waters of rain. Thereafter the earth, endowed with life, joins you. O Indra, destroyer of enemies and valiant, united with your strength and being the protector of the world, cause the waters belonging to the sky to pour down.

English translation

Your protecting thunderbolt has slain Vritra, obstructing the (issue of the waters), the conscious earth (co-operating) with (you): valiant hero, preserver (of the regions), send down by your strength the waters of the firmament.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒पो यदद्रिं॑ पुरुहूत॒ दर्द॑रा॒विर्भु॑वत्स॒रमा॑ पू॒र्व्यं ते॑ ।
स नो॑ ने॒ता वाज॒मा द॑र्षि॒ भूरिं॑ गो॒त्रा रु॒जन्नङ्गि॑रोभि
गृणा॒नः ॥ ८ ॥

> *apo yadadriṃ puruhūta dardarāvirbhuvatsaramā pūrvyaṃ te |*
> *sa no netā vājamā darṣi bhūriṃ gotrā rujannaṅgirobhirgṛṇānaḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अपः । यत् । अद्रिं । पुरुहूत । दर्दः । आविः । भुवत् । सरमा । पूर्व्यं । ते ।
> सः । नः । नेता । वाजं । आ । दर्षि । भूरिं । गोत्रा । रुजन् । अंगिरःभिः । गृणानः॥

> *apaḥ | yat | adriṃ | puruhūta | dardaḥ | āviḥ | bhuvat | saramā | pūrvyaṃ | te |*
> *saḥ | naḥ | netā | vājaṃ | ā | darṣi | bhūriṃ | gotrā | rujan | aṃgiraḥbhiḥ | gṛṇānaḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे पुरुहूत बहुभिराहूतेंद्र यद्यदापः प्रति वृष्टिलक्षणान्युदकानि लक्ष्मीकृत्याद्रिं मेघं दर्दः ।
> विदारितवानसि । सरमा देवशुनी पूर्व्यं पुरा ते तुभ्यं
> पणिभिरपहृतं गोधनमाविर्भुवत् । प्रकाशयामास । अंगिरोभिर्यषिभिर्गृणानः
> स्तूयमानः सन् गोत्रा गोत्राण्यभ्राणि रुजन् नोऽस्मान् भूरिं प्रभूतं वाजमन्नं नेता प्रापयिता स
> त्वमा दर्षि । आदरं कृतवानसि ॥

> *he puruhūta bahubhirāhūteṃdra yadyadāpaḥ prati*
> *vṛṣṭilakṣaṇānyudakāni lakṣmīkṛtyādriṃ meghaṃ dardaḥ |*
> *vidāritavānasi | saramā devaśunī pūrvyaṃ purā te tubhyaṃ*
> *paṇibhirapahṛtaṃ godhanamāvirbhuvat | prakāśayāmāsa |*
> *aṃgirobhiryaṣibhirgṛṇānaḥ*
> *stūyamānaḥ san gotrā gotrāṇyabhrāṇi rujan no 'smān bhūriṃ*
> *prabhūtaṃ vājamannaṃ netā prāpayitā sa tvamā darṣi | ādaraṃ*
> *kṛtavānasi ‖*

Summary

O Indra, invoked by many (पुरुहूत (*puruhūta*)): when, aiming at the waters in the form of rain, you split the cloud (अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)), Sarama, the divine bitch, in former times (पूर्व्यं (*pūrvyaṃ*)) revealed to you (आविर्भुवत् (*āvirbhuvat*): made manifest) the wealth of cattle carried off by the Paṇis. Being praised by the Aṅgirasa sages, breaking the गोत्रा (*gotrā*) (clouds), you, the leader who brings us abundant food (वाजं (*vājaṃ*)), have shown regard (आ दर्षि (*ā darṣi*)).

Word-to-word meaning

- पुरुहूत (*puruhūta*)—O Indra, who are invoked by many
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- अपः (*apaḥ*)—for the sprinkling of the waters of rain
- अद्रिं (*adriṃ*)—the cloud
- दर्दः (*dardaḥ*)—you split (then)
- सरमा (*saramā*)—Sarama
- पूर्व्यं (*pūrvyaṃ*)—standing before you
- ते (*te*)—to you
- आविर्भुवत् (*āvirbhuvat*)—revealed the cows
- अंगिरोभिः (*aṃgirobhiḥ*)—by the Aṅgirasa sages
- गृणानः (*gṛṇānaḥ*)—being praised
- गोत्रा (*gotrā*)—the clouds
- रुजन् (*rujan*)—splitting
- नः (*naḥ*)—us
- भूरि (*bhūri*)—abundant
- वाजं (*vājaṃ*)—towards food
- नेता (*netā*)—who bring
- सः (*saḥ*)—you
- आ दर्षि (*ā darṣi*)—have shown regard to us

Gist

O Indra, invoked by many: when you split the cloud so that the waters of rain might be sprinkled, Sarama (the divine bitch) stood before you and revealed the cows to you. Praised by the Aṅgirasa sages, splitting the clouds, and bringing us to abundant food, you have shown us great regard.

English translation

Invoked of many, when you had divided the cloud for (the escape of) the waters, Sarama appeared before you; and you, the bringer of abundant food, havs shewn us favour, divlding the clouds and glorified by the Angirasas.

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अच्छा॑ क॒विं नृ॑मणो गा अ॒भिष्टौ॒ स्व॑र्षाता मघव॒न्नाध॑मानम् ।
ऊ॒तिभि॒स्तमि॑षणो द्यु॒म्नहू॑तौ॒ नि मा॒यावा॒नब्र॑ह्मा॒ दस्यु॑रर्त ॥ ९ ॥

> *acchā kaviṃ nṛmaṇo gā abhiṣṭau svarṣātā maghavannādhamānam |*
> *ūtibhistamiṣaṇo dyumnahūtau ni māyāvānabrahmā dasyurarta ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अच्छ । कविं । नृमनः । गाः । अभिष्टौ । स्वसाता । मघवन् । नाधमानं ।
> ऊतिभिः । तं । इषणः । द्युम्नहूत् । नि । मायावान् । अब्रह्मा । दस्युः । अर्त॥

> *accha | kaviṃ | nṛmanaḥ | gāḥ | abhiṣṭau | svasātā | maghavan | nādhamānaṃ |*
> *ūtibhiḥ | taṃ | iṣaṇaḥ | dyumnahūt | ni | māyāvān | abrahmā | dasyuḥ | arta‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मघवन्थनवन्निंद्र नृमणः । नृभिर्मनुष्यैर्मनृत इति नृमणः । त्वं
> कविं मेधाविनं कुत्समच्छ गाः । अभ्यगाः । किंच स्वर्षाता । स्वर्धनं । तस्य सातौ
> दाने निमित्तेऽभिष्टौ कवेरभिगमे सति नाधमानं युद्धार्थं त्वां याचमानं
> कुत्समूतिभिः शत्रुकृतोपद्रवपरिहाररूपै रक्षणैरिषणः । प्रेरितवानसि । मायावान्
> कपटवानब्रह्मा । ऋत्विग्भिः क्रियमाणं सर्वं कर्मजातमनुज्ञारूपेण
> जानन् ऋत्विग्विशेषो ब्रह्मशब्देनोच्यते । स न विद्यते यस्य सोऽब्रह्मा । वेदोक्तकर्मस्वास्ति
> क्यरहित इत्यर्थः । दस्युः कुत्सस्य शत्रुर्दुम्नहूतौ द्युम्नं धनं हूतिराह्वानं यस्यां युधि तस्यां
> न्यर्त । विनष्टो बभूव । इंद्रः कुत्सेनाहूतः सन्
> तस्य शत्रुं हतवानित्यर्थः ॥

> *he maghavanthanavannimḍra nṛmaṇaḥ | nṛbhirmanuṣyèrmanṛta iti nṛmaṇaḥ | tvaṃ*
> *kaviṃ medhāvinaṃ kutsamaccha gāḥ | abhyagāḥ | kiṃca svarṣātā | svardhanaṃ | tasya sātau*
> *dāne nimitte 'bhiṣṭau kaverabhigame sati nādhamānaṃ yuddhārthaṃ tvāṃ yācamānaṃ*
> *kutsamūtibhiḥ śatrukṛtopadravaparihārarūpai rakṣaṇairiṣaṇaḥ | preritavānasi | māyāvān kapaṭavānabrahmā | ṛtvigniḥ kriyamāṇaṃ sarvaṃ karmajātamanujñārūpeṇa*
> *jānan ṛtvigviśeṣo brahmaśabdenocyate | sa na vidyate yasya so 'brahmā | vedoktakarmasvāsti kyarahita ityarthaḥ | dasyuḥ kutsasya śatrurdumnahūtau dyumnaṃ dhanaṃ hūtirāhvānaṃ yasyāṃ yudhi tasyāṃ nyarta | vinaṣṭo babhūva | iṃdraḥ kutsenāhūtaḥ san*
> *tasya śatruṃ hatavānityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

O wealthy Indra, नृमणः (*nṛmaṇaḥ*) (one thought of, i.e. honoured, by men), you went towards (*accha gāḥ*: अभ्यगाः (*abhyagāḥ*)) the wise (कविं (*kaviṃ*)) Kutsa. Moreover, on the approach of the sage (अभिष्टौ (*abhiṣṭau*)) for the sake of the gift (सातौ (*sātau*)) of heavenly wealth (स्वर्षाता (*svarṣātā*) = स्वर्धनं (*svardhanaṃ*)), you impelled (इषणः (*iṣaṇaḥ*)) Kutsa, who was begging (नाधमानं (*nādhamānaṃ*)) you for the battle, by your ऊतिभिः (*ūtibhiḥ*), protections that ward off the troubles caused by enemies. The Dasyu, Kutsa's enemy, who was मायावान् (*māyāvān*) (deceitful) and अब्रह्मा (*abrahmā*), was destroyed (न्यर्त (*nyarta*)) in the द्युम्नहूतौ (*dyumnahūtau*), the battle in which द्युम्नं (*dyumnaṃ*) (wealth) is the *hūtiḥ* (call). The word ब्रह्म (*brahma*) denotes a special ṛtvij who knows by way of sanction all the rites that are being performed; he who has none is अब्रह्मा (*abrahmā*), that is, one devoid of क्य (*kya*) in the rites enjoined by the Veda.[?454] The sense: Indra, called by Kutsa, killed his enemy.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- नृमणः (*nṛmaṇaḥ*)—you, worshipped by men
- कविं (*kaviṃ*)—of the wise Kutsa
- अच्छ (*accha*)—towards
- गाः (*gāḥ*)—you went (for his protection)
- स्वर्षाता (*svarṣātā*)—to give him wealth
- अभिष्टौ (*abhiṣṭau*)—when you went to him
- तं नाधमानं (*taṃ nādhamānaṃ*)—Kutsa, who was begging and calling you (for help in battle)
- ऊतिभिः (*ūtibhiḥ*)—with protections
- इषणः (*iṣaṇaḥ*)—you urged and impelled
- मायावान् (*māyāvān*)—the deceitful
- अब्रह्मा (*abrahmā*)—and devoid of Vedic rites
- दस्युः (*dasyuḥ*)—enemy (of Kutsa)
- द्युम्नहूतौ (*dyumnahūtau*)—in the battle that arose for wealth
- नि अर्त (*ni arta*)—was destroyed

Gist

O wealthy Indra, you, worshipped by men, went towards the wise Kutsa for his protection. When you went to give him wealth, you urged and impelled with protections Kutsa, who had begged and called you to help in battle.

The enemy, deceitful and devoid of Vedic rites, was slain by you while he was fighting with Kutsa for wealth.

English translation

Maghavan, you are honoured by men ; you have repaired to the presence of the sage for (the sake of) bestowing (upon him) wealth, and when soliciting (you) in his need (for aid): defending (him) with your protection, the guileful, impious Dasyu has been destroyed in the contest for the spoil.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

आ द॑स्यु॒घ्ना मन॑सा या॒ह्यस्तं॒ भुव॑त्ते॒ कुत्स॑ः स॒ख्ये निका॑मः ।
स्वे योनौ॒ नि ष॑दतं॒ सरू॑पा॒ वि वां॑ चिकित्सदृत॒चिद्ध॒ नारी॑ ॥ १० ॥

> *ā dasyughnā manasā yāhyastaṃ bhuvatte kutsaḥ sakhye nikāmaḥ |*
> *sve yonau ni ṣadataṃ sarūpā vi vāṃ cikitsadṛtaciddha nārī ‖ 10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> आ । दस्युघ्ना । मनसा । याहि । अस्तं । भुवत् । ते । कुत्सः । सख्ये । निकामः ।
> स्वे । योन्सौ । नि । सदतं । सरूपा । वि । वां । चिकित्सत् । ऋत्यचित् । ह । नारी ॥

> *ā | dasyughnā | manasā | yāhi | astaṃ | bhuvat | te | kutsaḥ | sakhye | nikāmaḥ |*
> *sve | yonsau | ni | sadataṃ | sarūpā | vi | vāṃ | cikitsat | ṛtyacit | ha | nārī ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अत्र काचिदाख्यायिका श्रूयते । कथं । रुरुनामकः कश्चिद्राजर्षिः । तस्य पुत्रः कुत्साख्यो राजर्षिरासीत् । स च कदाचिच्छतुभिः सह युयुत्तुः संग्रामे स्वयमशक्तः सन् शत्रूणां हननार्थमिंद्रस्याह्वानं चकार । स चेंद्रः कुत्सस्य गृहमागत्य तस्य शत्रून् जघान । तदनंतरमतिप्रीत्या तयोः सख्यमभवत् । सख्यानंतरमिंद्र एनमपि स्वकीयं गृहं प्रापयामास । तत्र शचींद्रं प्राप्तमागता सती तौ समानरूपौ दृष्ट्वायमिंद्रोऽयं कुत्स इति विवेकाभावेन संशयं

> चकारेति । अनयाख्यायिकया प्रतीयमानोऽर्थोऽत्र प्रतिपाद्यते । हे इंद्र
> दस्युघ्ना दस्यूनां शत्रूणां हंत्रा मनसा युक्तस्वमस्तं कुत्सस्य गृहं । अस्तमिति
> गृहनामैतत् । आ याहि । आगाः ॥ लुजर्थे लोट् ॥ कुत्सश्च ते तव संबंधिनि सख्ये
> निकामो नितरां कामयमानो भुवत् । अभवत् । ततस्तौ युवां स्वे योन्

> *atra kācidākhyāyikā śrūyate | katham̦ | rurunāmakaḥ kaścidrājarṣiḥ | tasya*
> *putraḥ kutsākhyo rājarṣirāsīt | sa ca kadācicchatubhiḥ saha yuyuttuḥ saṃgrāme*
> *svayamaśaktaḥ san śatrūṇāṃ hananārthamiṃdrasyāhvānaṃ cakāra | sa ceṃdraḥ kutsasya*
> *gṛhamāgatya tasya śatrūn jaghāna | tadanaṃtaramatiprītyā tayoḥ*
> *sakhyamabhavat | sakhyānaṃtaramiṃdra enamapi svakīyaṃ gṛhaṃ*
> *prāpayāmāsa | tatra śacīṃdraṃ prāptamāgatā*
> *satī tau samānarūpau dṛṣṭvāyamiṃdro 'yaṃ kutsa iti vivekābhāvena saṃśayaṃ*
> *cakāreti | anayākhyāyikayā pratīyamāno 'rtho 'tra pratipādyate | he iṃdra*
> *dasyughnā dasyūnāṃ śatrūṇāṃ haṃtrā manasā yuktasvamastaṃ kutsasya gṛhaṃ | astamiti*
> *gṛhanāmaitat | ā yāhi | āgāḥ ‖ lujarthe loṭ ‖ kutsaśca te tava saṃbaṃdhini sakhye*
> *nikāmo nitarāṃ kāmayamāno bhuvat | abhavat | tatastau yuvāṃ sve yon*

> स्वकीये स्थाने नि षदतं । न्यसीदतं । उपविष्टावभूतु । ऋतचित्सत्यदर्शिनी नारींद्रस्य भार्या
> शची सरूपा समानरूपौ वां युवां वि चिकित्सत् । संशयं चकार ॥

> *svakīye sthāne ni ṣadataṃ | nyasīdataṃ | upaviṣṭāvabhūtu |*
> *ṛtacitsatyadarśinī nārīṃdrasya bhāryā śacī sarūpā samānarūpau vāṃ*
> *yuvāṃ vi cikitsat | saṃśayaṃ cakāra ‖*

Summary

Here a certain story is heard. There was a royal sage named Ruru; his son was the royal sage called Kutsa. Once, wishing to fight enemies in battle and being unable himself, Kutsa called Indra to slay them. Indra came to Kutsa's house and killed his enemies. After that, from great affection, friendship arose between them. After the friendship Indra took Kutsa too to his own house. There Śacī, coming when Indra had arrived, saw the two of the same form and, unable to distinguish "this is Indra, this is Kutsa", fell into doubt. The meaning understood from this story is set forth here: O Indra, come with a mind that slays the Dasyus (enemies) to Kutsa's house (अस्तं (*astaṃ*) is a name for house); आ याहि (*ā yāhi*) stands for आगाः (*āgāḥ*), the Loṭ being used in the sense of Luṅ. And Kutsa became निकामः (*nikāmaḥ*), intensely desirous, of friendship with you (भुवत् (*bhuvat*) = अभवत् (*abhavat*)). Then the two of you … in your own योन् (*yon*) … (the window ends here, mid-sentence).

(This block continues from the previous window.) The two of you are to sit down in your own place; "may you be seated". The truth-seeing woman, Śacī, Indra's wife, seeing the two of you alike in form, fell into doubt about you.

Word-to-word meaning

- दस्युघ्ना (*dasyughnā*)—(O Indra) slayer of the Dasyu
- मनसा (*manasā*)—you who are endowed with a mind (set on it)
- अस्तं (*astaṃ*)—to (Kutsa's) house
- आ याहि (*ā yāhi*)—deign to come
- कुत्सः (*kutsaḥ*)—Kutsa too
- ते सख्ये (*te sakhyè*)—in gaining your friendship
- निकामः (*nikāmaḥ*)—intensely desirous
- भुवत् (*bhuvat*)—has become (then the two of you)
- स्वे योन्सौ (*sve yonsau*)—in your house
- नि षदतं (*ni ṣadataṃ*)—sit down
- ऋतचित् (*ṛtacit*)—capable of seeing the truth
- नारी (*nārī*)—Indra's wife
- सरूपा (*sarūpā*)—possessing a similar form
- वां (*vāṃ*)—seeing the two of you
- वि चिकित्सत् (*vi cikitsat*)—fell into doubt

Gist

O Indra, with a mind set on slaying the Dasyu, deign to come to Kutsa's house. Kutsa too is eager to gain your friendship. Then the two of you go to your house and sit down together. Indra's wife, who is capable of seeing the truth, seeing the two of you of similar form, fell into doubt.

English translation

With a mind resolved on killing the Dasyu, you came (to his dwelling), and Kutsa was eager for your friendship : now have you two alighted in his, (Indra's), habitation, and, being entirely similar in form, the truthful woman has been perplexed (to discriminate between you).

Special Topics

Concerning the matter spoken of in this Ṛk, the commentator has told a story (ākhyāyikā): रुरुनामकः कश्चिद्राजर्षिः । तस्य पुत्रः कुत्साख्यो राजर्षिरासीत् । स च कदाचित् शत्रुभिः सह युयुत्सुः संग्रामे स्वयमशक्तः सन् शत्रूणां हननार्थमिंद्रस्य आह्वानं चकार । स चेंद्रः कुत्सस्य गृहमागत्य तस्य शत्रून् जघान । तदनंतरमतिप्रीत्या तयोः सख्यमभवत् । सख्यानंतरमिंद्र एनमपि स्वकीयं गृहु प्रापयामास । तत्र शची इंद्रं प्राप्तुमागता सती तौ समानरूपौ दृष्ट्वा अयमिंद्रोऽयं कुत्स इति विवेकाभावेन संशयं चकार । अनयाख्यायिकया प्रतीयमानोऽर्थोऽत्र प्रतिपाद्यते ॥ (*rurunāmakaḥ kaścidrājarṣiḥ | tasya putraḥ kutsākhyo rājarṣirāsīt | sa ca kadācit śatrubhiḥ saha yuyutsuḥ saṃgrāme svayamaśaktaḥ san śatrūṇāṃ hananārthamiṃdrasya āhvānaṃ cakāra | sa ceṃdraḥ kutsasya gṛhamāgatya tasya śatrūn jaghāna | tadanaṃtaramatiprītyā tayoḥ sakhyamabhavat | sakhyānaṃtaramiṃdra enamapi svakīyaṃ gṛhu prāpayāmāsa | tatra śacī iṃdraṃ prāptumāgatā satī tau samānarūpau dṛṣṭvā ayamiṃdro 'yaṃ kutsa iti vivekābhāvena saṃśayaṃ cakāra | anayākhyāyikayā pratīyamāno 'rtho 'tra pratipādyate ||*) (Sa Bhā. 4-16 10)[?455]

The Kannada gives the story thus: In former times there was a royal sage named Ruru. He had a son named Kutsa. Once he had to fight with enemies. Because the enemies were very strong, he could not face and conquer them alone; he sought Indra's help and invited him. Then Indra came to Kutsa's house and destroyed his enemies.

Thereby friendship arose between Kutsa and Indra. Afterwards Indra took Kutsa to his own house. At the door of the house Śacī, Indra's wife, came to welcome Indra, and seeing two men of the same form as Indra, did not know how to tell which was Indra and which was Kutsa, and voiced her doubt. This very matter is indicated in this Ṛk.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

यासि॒ कुत्से॑न स॒रथ॑म॒व॒स्युस्तो॒दो वात॑स्य॒ हर्यो॒रीशा॑नः ।
ऋ॒ज्रा वाजं॒ न गध्यं॒ युयू॑षन्क॒विर्यदह॒न्पार्या॑य॒ भूषा॑त् ॥ ११ ॥

> *yāsi kutsena sarathamavasyustodo vātasya haryorīśānaḥ |*
> *ṛjrā vājaṃ na gadhyaṃ yuyūṣankaviryadahanpāryāya bhūṣāt ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यासि । कुत्सेन । स्वरथं । अवस्युः । तोदः । वातस्य । हर्योः । ईशानः ।
> ऋज्रा । वाजं । न । गध्यं । युयूषन् । कविः । यत् । अहन् । पार्याय ।
> ।
> भूषात् ॥ ११ ॥

> *yāsi | kutsena | svarathaṃ | avasyuḥ | todaḥ | vātasya | haryoḥ | īśānaḥ |*
> *ṛjrā | vājaṃ | na | gadhyaṃ | yuyūṣan | kaviḥ | yat | ahan | pāryāya |*
> *|*
> *bhūṣāt ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र अवस्युः कुत्सस्य रक्षणमिच्छन् ॥ छंदसि क्यच् परेच्छायामपि दृश्यते ॥ तोदस्तोदकः शत्रूणां हिंसको वातस्य वायुसदृशयोर्वेगवतोर्हर्योरश्वयोरीशान ईश्वरस्त्वं कुत्सेन कुत्साख्येन राजर्षिणा सरथं समानरथं

> यासि । गच्छसि । गध्यं ग्राह्यं । गध्यं गृष्णातेः । ऋज्रा वाजं न गध्यं. युयूषन्नित्यपि निगमो भवतीति निरुक्तं । ५–१५ । वाजं नान्नमिव ऋज्रा ऋजुगामिनावश्वा
> युयूषन् स्वकीये रथे योजयन् कविः प्राज्ञः कुत्सो यद्यस्मिन्नहन्नहनि
> दिवसे पार्याय पारणाय आपन्निस्तरणाय भूषात् । प्रभवते । तस्मिन्नेव दिने
> कुत्सेन सरथं यासीति पूर्वेण संबंधः ॥

> *he iṃdra avasyuḥ kutsasya rakṣaṇamicchan ‖ chaṃdasi kyac parecchāyāmapi dṛśyate ‖ todastodakaḥ śatrūṇāṃ hiṃsako vātasya vāyusadṛśayorvegavatorharyoraśvayorīśāna īśvarastvaṃ kutsena kutsākhyena rājarṣiṇā sarathaṃ samānarathaṃ*
> *yāsi | gacchasi | gadhyaṃ grāhyaṃ | gadhyaṃ gṛṣṇāteḥ | ṛjrā vājaṃ na gadhyaṃ. yuyūṣannityapi nigamo bhavatīti niruktaṃ | 5-15 | vājaṃ nānnamiva ṛjrā ṛjugāmināvaśvā*
> *yuyūṣan svakīye rathe yojayan kaviḥ prājñaḥ kutso yadyasminnahannahani*
> *divase pāryāya pāraṇāya āpannistaraṇāya bhūṣāt | prabhavate | tasminneva dine*
> *kutsena sarathaṃ yāsīti pūrveṇa saṃbaṃdhaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, desiring Kutsa's protection (the affix kyac is seen also in the sense of desiring others), being the tormentor of enemies and lord of the two horses, swift as the wind, you go in the same chariot with the royal sage named Kutsa. गध्यं (*gadhyaṃ*) means "to be taken". Sāyaṇa quotes the Nirukta (5-15): ऋज्रा वाजं न गध्यं. युयूषन्नित्यपि निगमो भवतीति (*ṛjrā vājaṃ na gadhyaṃ. yuyūṣannityapi nigamo bhavatīti*). The sense: like food, the two straight-going horses, yoking them to his own chariot, the wise Kutsa becomes able, on the day when he is to cross over, to get across a calamity. On that very day you go with Kutsa in the same chariot; so it is connected with the preceding.

Word-to-word meaning

- अवस्युः (*avasyuḥ*)—desiring to protect Kutsa
- तोदः (*todaḥ*)—the tormentor of enemies
- वातस्य (*vātasya*)—of speed equal to the wind's movement
- हर्योः (*haryoḥ*)—of the horses
- ईशानः (*īśānaḥ*)—the lord; you who are such

- कुत्सेन (*kutsena*)—with Kutsa
- सरथं (*sarathaṃ*)—seated in one chariot
- यासि (*yāsi*)—you go
- यत् अहन् (*yat ahan*)—on which very day
- कविः (*kaviḥ*)—the wise Kutsa
- गध्यं (*gadhyaṃ*)—to be taken
- वाजं न (*vājaṃ na*)—running as if going to obtain food
- ऋज्रा (*ṛjrā*)—and straight-going horses
- युयूषन् (*yuyūṣan*)—yoking to his chariot
- पाराया (*pārāyā*)—to cross deep water
- भूषात् (*bhūṣāt*)—becomes able

Gist

O Indra, desiring to protect Kutsa, you, the tormentor of enemies and lord of horses whose speed equals the wind's, go seated in one chariot with Kutsa on whatever day; on that very day Kutsa too, yoking to his chariot the straight-going horses that run as if hastening to obtain the food to be taken, becomes able to cross deep water.

English translation

You went with Kutsa, in the same chariot, determined to defend him ; (you who are) the tormentor (of foes), the lord of horses (of the speed) of the wind : on the same day wherein, yoking (to the car) the straight- going steeds, as if to receive food, the sage (Kutsa) has been enabled to cross over (the sea) of calamity.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कुत्सा॑य॒ शुष्णं॑म॒शुषं॒ नि ब॑र्हीः प्रपि॒त्वे अह्न॒ः कुय॑वं स॒हस्रा॑ ।
स॒द्यो दस्यू॒न्प्र मृ॑ण कु॒त्स्येन॒ प्र सूर॑श्च॒क्रं वृ॑हताद॒भी॑के ॥ १२ ॥

> *kutsāya śuṣṇamaśuṣaṃ ni barhīḥ prapitve ahnaḥ kuyavaṃ sahasrā |*
> *sadyo dasyūnpra mṛṇa kutsyena pra sūraścakraṃ vṛhatādabhīke ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कुत्साय । शुद्धं । अरुषु । नि । बर्हीः । प्रपित्वे । अह्नः । कुयवं । सहस्रा ।
> सद्यः । दस्यून् । प्र । मृण । कुत्स्येन । प्र । सूरः । चक्रं । वृहतात् । अभीके ॥

> *kutsāya | śuddhaṃ | aruṣu | ni | barhīḥ | prapitve | ahnaḥ | kuyavaṃ | sahasrā |*
> *sadyaḥ | dasyūn | pra | mṛṇa | kutsyena | pra | sūraḥ | cakraṃ | vṛhatāt | abhīke ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> शुष्णं पिप्रमित्यस्यामृचि । ऋग्वे. १–१०३–८ । प्रतिपादितोऽर्थः कुत्सायेत्यनेन ऋग्वयेन स्पष्टिक्रियते । हे इंद्र त्वं कुत्साय कुत्सार्थमशुषं । शूषमिति सुखनामैतत् । तद्रहितं । अत्र दीर्घाभावः । शुष्णं शुष्णनामानमसुरं नि बर्हिः । न्यबर्हिः। अवधीः । तथाह्नो दिवसस्य प्रपित्वे प्रक्रमे पूर्वाणे कुयवं कुयवनामानमसुरं च हतवानसि । तथा स त्वं सहस्रां सहस्रेण बहुभिः परिजनैः सह सद्यो यस्मिन् काले कुयवनवधीस्तस्मिन् काल एव कुत्सैन । कुत्स इति वज्रनामैतत् । कुत्स एव कुत्सं वज्रं । तेन दस्यून् शत्रून्नृ मृण । जहि ॥ भूतार्धे लोट् ॥ हतवानसि । तथा सूरः प्रेरकस्य सूर्यस्य चक्रमायुधमभीके समीपे संग्रामे ना प्र वृहतात् । प्रकर्षेण छिन्नवानसि ॥

> *śuṣṇaṃ pipramityasyāmṛci | ṛgve. 1-103-8 | pratipādito 'rthaḥ kutsāyetyanena ṛgvayena spaṣṭikriyate | he iṃdra tvaṃ kutsāya kutsārthamaśuṣaṃ | śūṣamiti sukhanāmaitat | tadrahitaṃ | atra*

> *dīrghābhāvaḥ | śuṣṇaṃ śuṣṇanāmānamasuraṃ ni*
> *barhiḥ | nyabarhiḥ| avadhīḥ | tathāhno divasasya prapitve prakrame pūrvāṇe kuyavaṃ*
> *kuyavanāmānamasuraṃ ca hatavānasi | tathā sa tvaṃ sahasrāṃ sahasreṇa bahubhiḥ parijanaiḥ*
> *saha sadyo yasmin kāle kuyavanavadhīstasmin kāla eva kutsaina | kutsa iti vajranāmaitat | kutsa eva kutsaṃ vajraṃ | tena dasyūn śatrūnnṛ*
> *mṛṇa | jahi ‖ bhūtārdhe loṭ ‖ hatavānasi | tathā sūraḥ prerakasya sūryasya cakramāyudhamabhīke*
> *samīpe saṃgrāme nā pra vṛhatāt | prakarṣeṇa chinnavānasi ‖*

Summary

The meaning set forth in the Ṛk beginning *śuṣṇaṃ pipraṃ* (Ṛgve. 1-103-8)[?456] is made plain by the two Ṛks beginning कुत्साय (*kutsāya*). O Indra, for Kutsa's sake you slew Śuṣṇa, the asura of that name, who is *aśuṣaṃ*: *śūṣaṃ* is a name for happiness, so he is devoid of it (no lengthening here). Likewise, at the beginning of the day, in the forenoon, you slew the asura named Kuyava. So you, with thousands, with many attendants, at the very time when you slew Kuyava, with कुत्स (*kutsa*)—this is a name of the thunderbolt, कुत्स (*kutsa*) itself being कुत्सं (*kutsaṃ*), the vajra—smote the Dasyus, the enemies; you have slain them. Likewise you cut to pieces, in the battle near at hand, the wheel, the weapon, of Sūrya the impeller.

Word-to-word meaning

- कुत्साय (*kutsāya*)—for Kutsa
- अरुषं (*aruṣaṃ*)—devoid of happiness
- शुष्णं (*śuṣṇaṃ*)—the asura named Śuṣṇa
- नि बर्हिः (*ni barhiḥ*)—you have slain
- अह्नः (*ahnaḥ*)—of the day
- प्रपित्वे (*prapitve*)—in the forenoon, the beginning
- सहस्रा (*sahasrā*)—with thousands of followers
- कुयवं (*kuyavaṃ*)—the asura named Kuyava, too, you destroyed
- सद्यः (*sadyaḥ*)—at once
- कुत्स्येन (*kutsyena*)—with the thunderbolt
- दस्यून् (*dasyūn*)—the enemies

- प्र मृण (*pra mṛṇa*)—you have destroyed
- सूरः (*sūraḥ*)—of the Sun
- चक्रं(*cakraṃ*)—the wheel
- अभीके(*abhīke*)—in battle
- प्र वृहतात् (*pra vṛhatāt*)—you have cut

Gist

O Indra, to help Kutsa you have slain the asura Śuṣṇa, who is devoid of happiness. In the forenoon, the beginning of the day, with thousands of followers, you destroyed also the asura Kuyava. At once, with the thunderbolt, you destroyed the enemies. In battle you cut the Sun's wheel.

English translation

For Kutsa, you have slain the unhappy Shushna, and, in the forepart of the day, attended by thousands, (you have slain) Kuyava with the thunder-bolt: you have swiftly destroyed the Dasyus, and you have cut them to pieces in the battle, with the wheel (of the chariot of) the sun.

Special Topics

The matter spoken of in this Ṛk and in the next Ṛk is also explained in Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-103-8. The matter of Śuṣka and Pipu we have explained in Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 10, pages 550, 551 and other places.

Ṛk 13

Samhitā-pāṭha

त्वं पिप्रुं॒ मृग॑यं शूशु॒वांसं॑मृ॒जिश्व॑ने वैदथि॒नाय॑ रन्धीः

।

प॒ञ्चा॒शत्कृ॒ष्णा नि व॑पः स॒हस्रात्कं॒ न पुरो॑ जरि॒मा

वि द॑र्दः ॥ १३ ॥

> *tvaṃ pipruṃ mṛgayaṃ śūśuvāṃsamṛjiśvane vaidathināya randhīḥ |*
> *pañcāśatkṛṣṇā ni vapaḥ sahasrātkaṃ na puro jarimā vi dardaḥ ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । पिपुं । मृगयं । शूशुवांसं । ऋजिश्वने । वैदथिनाय । रंधीः ।
> पंचाशत् । कृष्णा । नि । वपः । सहस्रा । अत्मं । न । पुरः । जरिमा। वि । दर्दरिति दर्दः॥

> *tvaṃ | pipuṃ | mṛgayaṃ | śūśuvāṃsaṃ | ṛjiśvane | vaidathināya | raṃdhīḥ |*
> *paṃcāśat | kṛṣṇā | ni | vapaḥ | sahasrā | atmaṃ | na | puraḥ | jarimā| vi | dardariti dardaḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं पिपुं पिपुनामानमसुरं शूशुवांसं प्रवृद्धं मृगयं
> मृगयनामानमसुरं च हतवानसि । किंच स त्वं वैदथिनाय विदथिनः पुत्राय
> ऋजिश्विने ऋजिश्वनाम्ने राजे रंधीः । वशमनयः । पंचाशत्पंचाशत्संख्याकानि
> सहस्रा सहस्राणि कृष्णा कृष्णवर्णानि रक्षांसि न वपः । न्यवपः । अवधिः । तथा स त्वं
> जरिमा जरात्कं न वयोविशेषं रूपमिव पुरः शंबरस्य नगराणि वि दर्दः । विदारितवानसि ॥

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ pipuṃ pipunāmānamasuraṃ śūśuvāṃsaṃ pravṛddhaṃ mṛgayaṃ*
> *mṛgayanāmānamasuraṃ ca hatavānasi | kiṃca sa tvaṃ vaidathināya vidathinaḥ putrāya*
> *ṛjiśvine ṛjiśvanāmne rāje raṃdhīḥ | vaśamanayaḥ | paṃcāśatpaṃcāśatsaṃkhyākāni*
> *sahasrā sahasrāṇi kṛṣṇā kṛṣṇavarṇāni rakṣāṃsi na vapaḥ | nyavapaḥ | avadhiḥ | tathā sa tvaṃ*
> *jarimā jarātkaṃ na vayoviśeṣaṃ rūpamiva puraḥ śaṃbarasya nagarāṇi vi dardaḥ | vidāritavānasi ‖*

Summary

O Indra, you slew Pipu, the asura of that name, and the grown-great Mṛgaya, the asura named Mṛgaya. Further, you brought under sway the king named Ṛjiśvan, son of Vidathin. You smote fifty thousand black-coloured rākṣasas. And you tore apart the cities of Śambara, like old age (जरिमा (*jarimā*)) destroying a particular age or form.

Word-to-word meaning

- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- पिप्रुं (*pipruṃ*)—the asura named Pipru
- शूशुवांसं (*śūśuvāṃsaṃ*)—the grown-great
- मृगयं (*mṛgayaṃ*)—the asura named Mṛgaya
- वैदथिनाय (*vaidathināya*)—for the son of Vidathin
- ऋजिश्वने (*ṛjiśvane*)—for the king named Ṛjiśvan
- रंधीः (*raṃdhīḥ*)—you made subject to yourself
- पंचाशत् सहस्रा (*paṃcāśat sahasrā*)—fifty thousand in number
- कृष्णा (*kṛṣṇā*)—of black colour, the asuras
- नि वपः (*ni vapaḥ*)—you destroyed
- जरिमा (*jarimā*)—old age
- अत्यं न (*atyaṃ na*)—as it destroys the form of a man
- पुरः (*puraḥ*)—the cities (of Śambara)
- वि दर्दः (*vi dardaḥ*)—you have destroyed

Gist

O Indra, you made subject to yourself the asura Pipu and the grown-great asura Mṛgaya, to help the king named Ṛjrśvan[?457] son of Vidadhi[?458]. You destroyed the asuras (Dasyus), fifty thousand in number and black in colour. As old age destroys the form of a man, you destroyed the cities of Śambara.

English translation

You have subjugated Pipru and the mighty Mrigaya for the sake of Rijishwan, the son of Vidathin; you have slain the fifty thousand Krishnas; and, as old age (destroys) life, you hast demolished the cities (of Shambara).

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

सूर॑ उपा॒के त॒न्वं१॒॑ दधा॑नो॒ वि यत्ते॒ चेत्य॒मृत॑स्य॒ वर्पः॑ ।
मृ॒गो न ह॒स्ती तवि॑षीमुषा॒णः सिं॒हो न भी॒म आयु॑धानि॒ बिभ्र॑त् ॥ १४ ॥

> *sūra upāke tanvaṃ dadhāno vi yatte cetyamṛtasya varpaḥ |*
> *mṛgo na hastī taviṣīmuṣāṇaḥ siṃho na bhīma āyudhāni bibhrat ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सूरः । उपाके । तन्वं । दधानः । वि । यत् । ते । चेति । अमृतस्य । वर्षः ।
> मृगः । न । हस्ती । तविषीं । उषाणः । सिंहः । न । भीमः । आयुधानि: बिभ्रत् ॥१४॥

> *sūraḥ | upāke | tanvaṃ | dadhānaḥ | vi | yat | te | ceti | amṛtasya | varṣaḥ |*
> *mṛgaḥ | na | hastī | taviṣīṃ | uṣāṇaḥ | siṃhaḥ | na | bhīmaḥ | āyudhāni: bibhrat ‖14‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र सूरः प्रेरकस्य सूर्यसोपाके समीपे तन्नं त्वदीयं शरीरं
> यद्यदा दधानो धारकोऽभवः तदामृतस्य मरणरहितस्य ते त्वदीयं वर्पो
> रूपं वि चेति । व्यचेति । हे इंद्र ज्ञातृभिर्विशेषेणाज्ञायत । सूर्यस्य समीपे
> सर्वाणि रूपाणि मलिनीभवंति न तथेंद्रस्य रूपं किंतु सूर्यस्य समीप इंद्रस्य
> रूपं विशेषेण भासमानं बभोनेत्यर्थः । अपि च हे इंद्र हस्ती मृगो न गजविशेषो मृग इव
> तविषीं परेषां बलमुषाणो दहन् आयुधानि वज्रादीनि
> शस्त्राणि बिभ्रद्बिभ्राणस्त्वं सिंहो न सिंह इव भीमो भयंकरोऽभूः ॥

> *he iṃdra sūraḥ prerakasya sūryasopāke samīpe tannaṃ tvadīyaṃ śarīraṃ*
> *yadyadā dadhāno dhārako 'bhavaḥ tadāmṛtasya maraṇarahitasya te tvadīyaṃ varpo*
> *rūpaṃ vi ceti | vyaceti | he iṃdra jñātṛbhirviśeṣeṇājñāyata | sūryasya*

> *samīpe*
> *sarvāṇi rūpāṇi malinībhavaṃti na tatheṃdrasya rūpaṃ kiṃtu sūryasya samīpa iṃdrasya*
> *rūpaṃ viśeṣeṇa bhāsamānaṃ babhonetyarthaḥ | api ca he iṃdra hastī mṛgo na gajaviśeṣo mṛga iva taviṣīṃ pareṣāṃ balamuṣāṇo dahan āyudhāni vajrādīni*
> *śastrāṇi bibhradvibhrāṇastvaṃ siṃho na siṃha iva bhīmo bhayaṃkaro 'bhūḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, when you became the bearer of your body near Sūrya the impeller, then your immortal, deathless form was distinctly known by those who know. Near the Sun all forms become dim, but not so Indra's form; the sense is that near the Sun Indra's form shone out distinctly. And further, O Indra, like a "hand-possessing beast" (हस्ती मृगो (*hastī mṛgo*), a particular kind of elephant), robbing, burning up, the strength of others, bearing weapons such as the thunderbolt, you became terrible, fearsome, like a lion.

Word-to-word meaning

- सूरः (*sūraḥ*)—of the sun, the impeller of all
- उपाके(*upāke*)—in the proximity
- तन्नं (*tannaṃ*)—your body
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- दधानः (*dadhānaḥ*)—you stand bearing (then)
- अमृतस्य (*amṛtasya*)—of you who are free from death
- ते (*te*)—your
- वर्पः (*varpaḥ*)—form
- वि चेति (*vi ceti*)—shines forth the more
- हस्ती मृगो न (*hastī mṛgo na*)—like a forest elephant
- तविषीं (*taviṣīṃ*)—the strength of enemies
- उषाणः (*uṣāṇaḥ*)—diminishing
- आयुधानि (*āyudhāni*)—weapons such as the thunderbolt
- बिभ्रत् (*bibhrat*)—you who bear
- सिंहो न (*siṃho na*)—like a lion
- भीमः (*bhīmaḥ*)—you are terrible

Gist

O Indra, before the sun, the impeller of all, all other lights grow dim. But when you stand bearing your radiant body, your deathless form shines forth still more. Diminishing the strength of enemies like a forest elephant, and holding weapons such as the thunderbolt, you are terrible like a lion.

English translation

While having (your) person in the proximity of the sun, your form becomes redolent of ambrosia, and you are like the cervine elephant, consum-ing the strength (of the strong), and are like a terrible lion when wielding your weapons.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

इन्द्र॒ं कामा॑ वसू॒यन्तो॑ अग्म॒न्स्व॑र्मीळ्हे॒ न सव॑ने चका॒नाः ।
श्र॒व॒स्यव॑ः शशमा॒नास॑ उ॒क्थैरोको॒ न र॒ण्वा सु॒दृशी॑व पु॒ष्टिः ॥ १५ ॥

> *indraṃ kāmā vasūyanto agmansvarmīḷhe na savane cakānāḥ |*
> *śravasyavaḥ śaśamānāsa ukthairoko na raṇvā sudṛśīva puṣṭiḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> इंद्रं । कामाः । वसुयंतः । अग्मन् । स्वमीळ्हे । न । सवने । चकानाः ।
> श्रवस्यवः । शशमानासः । उक्षैः । ओकः । न । रण्वा । सुदृशीइव । पुष्टिः ॥ १५ ॥

> *iṃdraṃ | kāmāḥ | vasuyaṃtaḥ | agman | svamīḷhe | na | savane | cakānāḥ |*
> *śravasyavaḥ | śaśamānāsaḥ | ukṣaiḥ | okaḥ | na | raṇvā | sudṛśīiva | puṣṭiḥ ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> कामा राक्षसादिभयनिवारणार्थमिंद्रं कामयमाना वसूयंतः पश्वादिधनमिच्छंतः स्तोतार इंद्रं परमैश्वर्ययुक्तमग्मन् । गच्छंति ॥ वर्तमानार्थे
> छांदसो लुज् ॥ कीदृशाः स्तोतारः । स्वर्माळ्हे न युद्ध इव सवने यज्ञे
> चकाना याचामानाः श्रवस्यवोऽन्नकामा उक्तैः स्तोत्रैः शशमानासः शंसमानाः
> स्तुवंतः । तदा सोऽयमिंद्र ओको न स्तोत्कृणामावास इव भवति । रण्वा रमणीया सुदृशीव पुष्टिः शोभनदर्शना लक्ष्मीरिव भवति ॥

> *kāmā rākṣasādibhayanivāraṇārthamiṃdraṃ kāmayamānā vasūyaṃtaḥ paśvādidhanamicchaṃtaḥ stotāra iṃdraṃ paramaiśvaryayuktamagman | gacchaṃti ‖ vartamānārthe*
> *chāṃdaso luj ‖ kīdṛśāḥ stotāraḥ | svarmāḷhe na yuddha iva savane yajñe*
> *cakānā yācāmānāḥ śravasyavo 'nnakāmā uktaiḥ stotraiḥ śaśamānāsaḥ śaṃsamānāḥ*
> *stuvaṃtaḥ | tadā so 'yamiṃdra oko na stotkṛṇāmāvāsa iva bhavati | raṇvā ramaṇīyā sudṛśīva puṣṭiḥ śobhanadarśanā lakṣmīriva bhavati ‖*

Summary

The worshippers (kāmāḥ), longing for Indra to ward off fears from demons and the like, and desiring wealth such as cattle (vasūyantaḥ), approach Indra, endowed with supreme lordship; अग्मन् (*agman*) means "they go", a Vedic luñ in the sense of the present. What kind of worshippers? Those who, as in battle, so in the sacrifice (savana), beg for help, desire food (śravasyavaḥ), and praise with hymns (ukthaiḥ). Then this Indra becomes like a dwelling (oka) for the worshippers, and like lovely Lakṣmī, of beautiful appearance, the goddess of nourishment (puṣṭi).

Word-to-word meaning

- स्वर्मिळे न (*svarmiḷe na*)—as one trusts (Indra) in battle
- सवने (*savane*)—in sacrifices too
- चकानाः (*cakānāḥ*)—those who have taken refuge in him
- श्रवस्यवः (*śravasyavaḥ*)—those desiring food
- कामाः (*kāmāḥ*)—those who look to him for protection
- वसूयंतः (*vasūyaṃtaḥ*)—those desiring wealth; such worshippers
- उक्थैः (*ukthaiḥ*)—with hymns

- शशमानासः (*śaśamānāsaḥ*)—praising
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra, the lord
- अग्मन् (*agman*)—approach (then Indra)
- ओको न (*oko na*)—like a dwelling for the sacrificer
- रण्वा (*raṇvā*)—charming
- सुदृशीव (*sudṛśīva*)—like Lakṣmī, of beautiful nature
- पुष्टिः (*puṣṭiḥ*)—becomes the giver of nourishment

Gist

As one trusts Indra in battle, so in sacrifices too the worshippers who have taken refuge in him, desire food, look to him for protection and desire wealth, approach Indra the lord, praising him with hymns. Then Indra becomes a protector for the sacrificer like a dwelling, and a giver of nourishment like charming, beautiful Lakṣmī.

English translation

Relying (upon Indra) for protection, and desirous of riches, (pious men) repair to him soliciting his presence in the sacrifice, as if in the battle ; asking for food, celebrating his praise with hymns, for he is the refuge (of his worshippers), and resembles the grateful and lovely (goddess) of nutrition.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तमि॒द्व इन्द्रं॑ सु॒हवं॑ हुवेम॒ यस्ता च॒कार॒ नर्या॑ पु॒रूणि॑ ।
यो मावं॑ते जरि॒त्रे गध्यं॑ चिन्म॒क्षू वाजं॒ भरं॑ति स्पा॒र्हरा॑धाः ॥ १६ ॥

> *tamidva indraṃ suhavaṃ huvema yastā cakāra naryā purūṇi |*
> *yo māvate jaritre gadhyaṃ cinmakṣū vājaṃ bharati spārharādhāḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तं । इत् । वः । इंद्रं । सुहवं । हुवेम । यः । ता । चकार । नर्या । पुरूणि ।
> यः । मावते । जरित्रे । गध्यं । चित् । मक्षु । वाजं । भरति । स्पार्हराधाः ॥ १६ ॥

> *taṃ | it | vaḥ | iṃdraṃ | suhavaṃ | huvema | yaḥ | tā | cakāra | naryā | purūṇi |*
> *yaḥ | māvate | jaritre | gadhyaṃ | cit | makṣu | vājaṃ | bharati | spārharādhāḥ ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> य इंद्रो नर्या नर्याणि मनुष्यहितानि पुरूणि बहूनि ता तानि प्रसिद्धानि
> कर्माणि चकार । अकरोत् । किंच स्वाहर्हराधाः स्पृहणीयधनो य इंद्रो
> मावते मत्सदृशाय जरित्रे स्तोत्रे गध्यं चित् ग्राह्यं संयोजनीयमपि वाजमन्नं मक्षु शीघ्रं भरति ।
> आहरति । वयं स्तोतारो हे यजमाना वो युष्मभ्यं तमित्तमेवेंद्रं सुहवं शोभनमाह्वानं यथा
> भवति तथा हुवेनु । आह्वयामः !

> *ya iṃdro naryā naryāṇi manuṣyahitāni purūṇi bahūni tā tāni prasiddhāni*
> *karmāṇi cakāra | akarot | kiṃca svāharharādhāḥ spṛhaṇīyadhano ya iṃdro*
> *māvate matsadṛśāya jaritre stotre gadhyaṃ cit grāhyaṃ saṃyojanīyamapi vājamannaṃ makṣu śīghraṃ bharati | āharati |*
> *vayaṃ stotāro he yajamānā vo yuṣmabhyaṃ tamittameveṃdraṃ suhavaṃ śobhanamāhvānaṃ yathā bhavati tathā huvenu | āhvayāmaḥ !*

Summary

Indra who did those many well-known deeds beneficial to men (naryā); and Indra of enviable wealth (svārharādhāḥ) who swiftly brings food, even such as is hard to obtain or acceptable (gadhyam), to a praiser like me (māvate): to that very Indra we, the praisers, O sacrificers, call for you with a fair invocation.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—the Indra who
- नर्या (*naryā*)—beneficial to men
- पुरूणि (*purūṇi*)—of many kinds
- ता (*tā*)—and well-known; those deeds

- चकार (*cakāra*)—did
- स्वार्हराधाः (*svārharādhāḥ*)—possessing desired riches
- यः (*yaḥ*)—the Indra who
- मावते (*māvate*)—to one like me
- जरित्रे (*jaritre*)—the praiser
- गध्यं चित् (*gadhyaṃ cit*)—most acceptable
- वाजं (*vājaṃ*)—food
- मक्षु (*makṣu*)—swiftly
- भरति (*bharati*)—brings
- तमित् इंद्रं (*tamit iṃdraṃ*)—that very Indra
- सुहवं (*suhavaṃ*)—with an excellent invocation
- हुवेम (*huvema*)—we pray and call

Gist

O sacrificers, the Indra who did deeds beneficial to men, very famous and of many kinds, and who, possessing desired riches, swiftly brings most acceptable food to a praiser like me, that very Indra we pray and call with an excellent invocation.

English translation

Let us invoke that gracious Indra who has made so many things good for man; who, bestowing enviable opulence, quickly brings acceptable food to a worshipper like me.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ति॒ग्मा यद॒न्तर॒शनि॒◌ः पता॑ति॒ कस्मिं॑श्चिच्छूर मुहु॒के
जना॑नाम् ।
घो॒रा यदं॑र्य॒ समृं॑ति॒र्भवा॒त्यधं॑ स्मा नस्त॒न्वो॑ बोधि गो॒
पाः ॥ १७ ॥

> *tigmā yadantaraśaniḥ patāti kasmiñcicchūra muhuke janānām |*
> *ghorā yadarya samṛtirbhavātyadha smā nastanvo bodhi gopāḥ ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तिग्मा । यत् । अंतः । अशनिः । पताति । कस्मिन् । चित् । शूर । मुहुके । जनानां ।
> घोरा । यत् । आर्य । संऋतिः । भवाति । अध । स्म । नः । तन्नः । बोधि । गोपाः॥

> *tigmā | yat | aṃtaḥ | aśaniḥ | patāti | kasmin | cit | śūra | muhuke | janānāṃ |*
> *ghorā | yat | ārya | saṃṛtiḥ | bhavāti | adha | sma | naḥ | tannaḥ | bodhi | gopāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे शूर विक्रांतेंद्र यद्यदा कस्मिंश्चित्सर्वस्मिन्नपि जनानां मनुष्याणां
> मुहुके मोहके युद्धेऽंतरस्माकु मध्यॆ तिग्मा तीक्ष्णाशनिः पताति । पतेत् । हे
> अर्य स्वामिन्निंद्र यद्यदास्माकु शत्रुभिः सह घोरा भीमरूपा समृतियुद्धं
> भवाति । भवेत् । अध तदानीं नोऽस्मदीयस्य तन्नः शरीरस्य गोपा रक्षको बोधि
> स्मै । अबोधि । शत्रुभ्यः सकाशादस्मान्रक्षकत्वेन बुद्धवानसि खलु ॥

> *he śūra vikrāṃteṃdra yadyadā kasmiṃścitsarvasminnapi janānāṃ manuṣyāṇāṃ*
> *muhuke mohake yuddhe 'ṃtarasmāku madhyè tigmā tīkṣṇāśaniḥ patāti | patet | he*
> *arya svāminniṃdra yadyadāsmāku śatrubhiḥ saha ghorā bhīmarūpā samṛtiyuddhaṃ*
> *bhavāti | bhavet | adha tadānīṃ no 'smadīyasya tannaḥ śarīrasya gopā rakṣako bodhi*
> *smai | abodhi | śatrubhyaḥ sakāśādasmānrakṣakatvena buddhavānasi khalu ‖*

Summary

O heroic Indra, when in any bewildering (muhuke) battle of men a sharp thunderbolt falls among us, and when, O lord (arya), a terrible battle with enemies takes place, then you have been known by us as the protector of our bodies (tanvaḥ); बोधि स्म (*bodhi sma*) is "you have understood" — you have indeed shown yourself our protector against enemies.

Word-to-word meaning

- शूर (*śūra*)—O valiant one
- अर्य (*arya*)—O Indra, lord
- यत् (*yat*)—when
- जनानां (*janānāṃ*)—arisen among men
- कस्मिंश्चित् मुहुके(*kasmiṃścit muhuke*)—in whatever battle
- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the midst of us who fight
- तिग्मा (*tigmā*)—sharp
- अशनिः (*aśaniḥ*)—your thunderbolt
- पताति (*patāti*)—if it falls
- अध (*adha*)—at that time
- नः (*naḥ*)—our
- तन्नः (*tannaḥ*)—of bodies
- गोपाः (*gopāḥ*)—as protector
- बोधि स्म (*bodhi sma*)—are you not the one who is known?

Gist

O valiant Indra, lord, in whatever battle arisen among us men, if your sharp thunderbolt falls among us warriors, at that time you are known as the protector of our bodies, so as to cause your weapon not to fall on us, are you not?

English translation

Hero, Indra, when in any conflict of men the sharp thunderbolt falls in the midst (of them), and when, lord, there is a terrible battle, then the defender of our persons is made known.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

भुवो॑ऽवि॒ता वा॒मदे॑वस्य धी॒नां भुव॒ः सखा॑वृ॒को वाज॑
सातौ ।
त्वाम॒नु प्रम॑ति॒मा जं॑गन्मोरु॒शंसो॑ जरि॒त्रे वि॒श्वध॑
स्याः ॥ १८ ॥

> *bhuvo 'vitā vāmadevasya dhīnāṃ bhuvaḥ sakhāvṛko vājasātau |*
> *tvāmanu pramatimā jaganmoruśaṃso jaritre viśvadha syāḥ ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> भुवः । अविता । नाम्यदेवस्य । धीनां । भुवः । सखा । अवृकः । वाजसाता ।
> त्वां । अनु । प्रमतिं । आ । जगन्म । उरुशंसः । जरित्रे । विश्वध । स्याः ॥ १८ ॥

> *bhuvaḥ | avitā | nāmyadevasya | dhīnāṃ | bhuvaḥ | sakhā | avṛkaḥ | vājasātā |*
> *tvāṃ | anu | pramatiṃ | ā | jaganma | uruśaṃsaḥ | jaritre | viśvadha | syāḥ ‖ 18 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं वामदेवस्य वामदेवाख्यस्य मंत्रद्रष्टुर्मम संबंधिनीनां
> धीनां कर्मणामविता रक्षिता भुवः । भव । अवृको हिंसारहितस्त्वं वाजसात्
> युद्धे सखा मम सुहृद्भुवः । भव । हे इंद्र वयं प्रमतिं प्रकृष्टज्ञानं
> त्वामनु लक्ष्मीकृत्या जगन्म । आगच्छाम । स त्वं विश्वध सर्वदा जरित्रे स्तोत्र उरुरंसो महता
> शंसनेन युक्तः स्याः । भवेः ॥

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ vāmadevasya vāmadevākhyasya maṃtradraṣṭurmama saṃbaṃdhinīnāṃ*
> *dhīnāṃ karmaṇāmavitā rakṣitā bhuvaḥ | bhava | avṛko hiṃsārahitastvaṃ vājasāt*
> *yuddhe sakhā mama suhṛdbhuvaḥ | bhava | he iṃdra vayaṃ pramatiṃ*

> *prakṛṣṭajñānaṃ*
> *tvāmanu lakṣmīkṛtyā jaganma | āgacchāma | sa tvaṃ viśvadha sarvadā*
> *jaritre stotra ururaṃso mahatā śaṃsanena yuktaḥ syāḥ | bhaveḥ ||*

Summary

O Indra, be the protector of the acts (dhīnām) of me, the seer named Vāmadeva; be, harmless as you are, my friend in battle (vājasāt). O Indra, we come toward you (anu), of excellent wisdom (pramati), making you our aim. May you always be endowed with great praise (uruśaṃsaḥ) for the praiser.

Word-to-word meaning

- वामदेवस्य (*vāmadevasya*)—of me, Vāmadeva
- धीनां (*dhīnāṃ*)—of the acts
- अविता (*avitā*)—as protector
- भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*)—be
- अवृकः (*avṛkaḥ*)—you who are free from harming
- वाजसात् (*vājasāt*)—in battle
- सखा (*sakhā*)—
- (सखा (*sakhā*) continued) as a friend to me
- भुवः (*bhuvaḥ*)—be
- प्रमतिं (*pramatiṃ*)—possessing excellent wisdom
- त्वां अनु (*tvāṃ anu*)—aiming at you
- आ जगन्म (*ā jaganma*)—we come near you
- विश्वध (*viśvadha*)—always
- जरित्रे (*jaritre*)—to me the praiser
- उरुशंसः (*uruśaṃsaḥ*)—endowed with praiseworthy favour
- स्याः (*syāḥ*)—be

Gist

O Indra, be the protector of the acts of me, Vāmadeva. Harmless as you are, be my friend. Aiming at you, who have excellent wisdom, we come near you. For me, the praiser, be always endowed with praiseworthy favour.

English translation

Be the protector of the pious acts of Vamadeva; be in battle an unfailing friend: we come to you, eminent in wisdom; may you bc ever benignant to your praiser.

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒भिर्नृभि॑रिन्द्र त्वा॒युभि॑ष्ट्वा म॒घव॑द्भिर्मघव॒न्विश्व॑ आ॒जौ ।
द्यावो॒ न द्यु॒म्नैर॒भि सन्तो॑ अ॒र्यः क्ष॒पो म॑देम श॒रद॑
श्च पू॒र्वीः ॥ १९ ॥

> *ebhirnṛbhirindra tvāyubhiṣṭvā maghavadbhirmaghavanviśva ājau |*
> *dyāvo na dyumnairabhi santo aryaḥ kṣapo madema śaradaśca pūrvīḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एभिः । नृभिः । इंद्र । त्वायुभिः । त्वा । मघवत्भिः । मघवन् । विश्वे : आजौ ।
> द्यावः । न । द्युम्नैः । अभि । संतः । अर्यः । क्षपः । मवेम । शरवः । च । पूर्वीः ।

> *ebhiḥ | nṛbhiḥ | iṃdra | tvāyubhiḥ | tvā | maghavatbhiḥ | maghavan | viśve : ājau |*
> *dyāvaḥ | na | dyumnaiḥ | abhi | saṃtaḥ | aryaḥ | kṣapaḥ | mavema | śaravaḥ | ca | pūrvīḥ |*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मघवन्थनवन्निंद्र विश्वे विश्वस्मिन्नाजौ संग्रामे त्वायुभिः शत्रुजयार्थं
> त्वां कामयमानैर्मघवद्भिस्त्वदर्थं दीयमानहनिर्लक्षणैर्धनैरुपेतैरेभिः प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानैनृभिः
> पुत्रपौत्राद्यैः परिजनैः सहिता वयं यजमाना द्युम्नैर्धनैर्द्यावो न द्योतमानाः प्रकाशमाना धनिनो
> यथा तथार्योऽरीन् शत्रु–

> *he maghavanthanavanniṃdra viśve viśvasminnājau saṃgrāme tvāyubhiḥ śatrujayārthaṃ*
> *tvāṃ kāmayamānairmaghavadbhistvadarthaṃ dīyamānahanirlakṣaṇairdhanairupetairebhiḥ*

> *pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamānainṛbhiḥ putrapautrādyaiḥ parijanaiḥ sahitā vayaṃ yajamānā dyumnairdhanairdyāvo na dyotamānāḥ prakāśamānā dhanino yathā tathāryo 'rīn śatru-*

> नभि संतोऽभिभवंतः क्षपः सर्वा रात्रीः पूर्विर्बह्वीः शरदश्च संवत्सरांश्च मदेम।
> स्तनाम । यजमानाः सर्वेषु कालेषु स्तोत्रैरिंद्रं हर्षयंतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *nabhi saṃto 'bhibhavaṃtaḥ kṣapaḥ sarvā rātrīḥ pūrvirbahvīḥ śaradaśca saṃvatsarāṃśca madema|*
> *stanāma | yajamānāḥ sarvèṣu kāleṣu stotrairiṃdraṃ harṣayaṃtītyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

O wealthy Indra, in every battle (āji), we the sacrificers, accompanied by these visible men (nṛbhiḥ), sons, grandsons and other attendants, who desire you for victory over enemies (tvāyubhiḥ) and are endowed with wealth in the form of oblations given for you (maghavadbhiḥ), shine with riches (dyumnaiḥ) like the heavens (dyāvaḥ), like shining wealthy men, and … the enemies (aryaḥ) … (the sentence breaks off at the end of the window).

The sentence begun on the previous page ends here. We, the sacrificers, overcoming (अभि संतः (*abhi saṃtaḥ*)) our enemies, would glorify Indra through all nights (क्षपः (*kṣapaḥ*)) and through many autumns, that is, years (*śaradaḥ*), with hymns of praise on every occasion. The meaning is that the sacrificers gladden Indra with hymns.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy one
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- विश्वे (*viśve*)—in all
- आजौ (*ājau*)—in battle
- त्वायुभिः (*tvāyubhiḥ*)—those who desire you (for victory over enemies)
- मघवद्भिः (*maghavadbhiḥ*)—and who are endowed with wealth in the form of oblations

- एभिः नृभिः (*ebhiḥ nṛbhiḥ*)—together with these followers, sons, grandsons and others
- द्युम्नैः (*dyumnaiḥ*)—endowed with wealth and prosperity
- द्यावो न (*dyāvo na*)—like wealthy people who are resplendent
- अर्यः (*aryaḥ*)—the enemies
- अभि संतः (*abhi saṃtaḥ*)—defeating completely
- क्षपः (*kṣapaḥ*)—in all nights
- पूर्विः (*pūrviḥ*)—many
- शरदश्च (*śaradaśca*)—and in years
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- मदेम (*madema*)—may we come to praise

Gist

O wealthy Indra, in every battle, together with these followers, sons, grandsons and others, who desire you for victory over the enemy and are endowed with wealth in the form of oblations, may we, like wealthy and resplendent people, completely defeating our enemies, come to praise you day and night for many years.

English translation

In every battle, Maghavan, may we, along with those men who trust in you and offer rich gifts, like those who are resplendent with riches, triumphing over their foes, glorify you many nights and years.

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒वेदिन्द्रा॑य वृष॒भाय॒ वृष्णे॒ ब्रह्मा॑कर्म॒ भृग॑वो॒ न रथ॑म् ।
नू चि॒द्यथा॑ नः स॒ख्या वि॒योष॒दस॑न्न उ॒ग्रो॑ऽवि॒ता त॑नू॒पाः ॥ २० ॥

> *evedindrāya vṛṣabhāya vṛṣṇe brahmākarma bhṛgavo na ratham |*
> *nū cidyathā naḥ sakhyā viyoṣadasanna ugro 'vitā tanūpāḥ ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एव । इत् । इंद्राय । वृषभाय । वृष्णे । ब्रह्म । अकर्म । भृगवः । न । रथं ।
> नु । चित् । यथा । नः । सख्या । वियोषत् । असत् । नः । उग्रः । अविता। तनूपाः॥

> *eva | it | iṃdrāya | vṛṣabhāya | vṛṣṇe | brahma | akarma | bhṛgavaḥ | na | rathaṃ |*
> *nu | cit | yathā | naḥ | sakhyā | viyoṣat | asat | naḥ | ugraḥ | avitā| tanūpāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यथेंद्रो नोऽस्मदीयानि सख्या सख्यानि कर्माणि नू चित् वियोषत्
> न पृथक्कुर्यात् । उग्रस्तेजस्वी तनूपाः शरीराणां पालक इंद्रो यथा नोऽस्मानविता रक्षितासत् ।
> स्यात् । तथा वयं यजमाना एवेदेवमेवोक्तप्रकारेणेंद्राय वृषभाय कामानां वर्षित्रे वृष्णे
> नित्यतरुणाय ब्रह्म स्तोत्रमकर्म ।
> अकुर्म । तत्र दृष्टांतः । भृगवो दीप्तास्तक्षाणो रथं न रथमिव तद्वत् । यजमानेभ्यो
> यथेंद्रोऽभीपिस्तिफलप्रदो भवति तथेंद्रं यजमानाः स्तुवंतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *yatheṃdro no 'smadīyāni sakhyā sakhyāni karmāṇi nū cit viyoṣat*
> *na pṛthakkuryāt | ugrastejasvī tanūpāḥ śarīrāṇāṃ pālaka iṃdro yathā no 'smānavitā rakṣitāsat | syāt | tathā vayaṃ yajamānā evedevamevoktaprakāreṇeṃdrāya vṛṣabhāya kāmānāṃ varṣitre vṛṣṇe*
> *nityataruṇāya brahma stotramakarma |*
> *akurma | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ | bhṛgavo dīptāstakṣāṇo rathaṃ na rathamiva tadvat | yajamānebhyo yatheṃdro 'bhīpistiphalaprado bhavati*
> *tatheṃdraṃ yajamānāḥ stuvaṃtītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

As Indra would never (नू चित् (*nū cit*)) separate (वियोषत् (*viyoṣat*)) from us our friendly (सख्या (*sakhyā*)) deeds, and as Indra, fierce, that is radiant, and तनूपाः (*tanūpāḥ*), the protector of bodies, would be (असत् (*asat*)) our protector (अविता (*avitā*)), so we sacrificers, in the manner stated, have made (अकर्म (*akarma*)) a hymn (ब्रह्म (*brahma*)) for Indra, the bull (वृषभाय (*vṛṣabhāya*)), the showerer of desires, the ever-young

(वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*)). The illustration: like the shining Bhṛgus, that is, carpenters, a chariot (रथं न (*ratham̩ na*)). The meaning is that as Indra gives the desired fruit to sacrificers, so the sacrificers praise Indra.

Word-to-word meaning

- यथा (*yathā*)—in what manner (for what reason)
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- नः (*naḥ*)—with us
- सख्या (*sakhyā*)—friendship
- नू चित् (*nū cit*)—immediately
- वियोषत् (*viyoṣat*)—would not leave (and)
- यथा (*yathā*)—for what reason
- उग्रः (*ugraḥ*)—radiant
- तनूपाः (*tanūpāḥ*)—Indra, protector of our bodies
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- अविता (*avitā*)—as protector
- असत् (*asat*)—would be (for that purpose)
- एवेत् (*evet*)—just as resolved above
- वृषभाय (*vṛṣabhāya*)—showerer of desires
- वृष्णे (*vṛṣṇe*)—young
- इंद्राय (*iṃdrāya*)—for Indra
- भृगवः (*bhṛgavaḥ*)—the shining Bhṛgus (smiths)
- रथं न (*rathaṃ na*)—as they build a chariot
- ब्रह्म (*brahma*)—a hymn
- अकर्म (*akarma*)—we make

Dharmārtha

So that Indra may at once not abandon the truth that is with us, and with the prayer that Indra, radiant and protector of our bodies, may be our complete protector, we too, just as resolved above, make a hymn for Indra, the showerer of desires and ever young, as the shining smiths build an excellent chariot.

English translation

Therefore we offer to the vigorous Indra, the showerer (of benefits), holy adoration, that he may never withdraw his friendly (actions) from us, and that he may be our powerful protector, the defender of (our) persons, as the Bhrigus (fabricate) a car (for use).

Ṛk 21

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नू ष्टु॒त इ॑न्द्र॒ नू गृ॑णा॒न इ॒षं॑ ज॒रि॒त्रे न॒द्यो॒३॒॑ न पी॑
पेः ।
अका॑रि ते हरि॒वो ब्रह्म॒ नव्यं॑ धि॒या स्या॑म र॒
थ्यं॑◌ः सदा॒साः ॥ २१ ॥

> *nū ṣṭuta indra nū gṛṇāna iṣaṃ jaritre nadyo na pīpeḥ |*
> *akāri te harivo brahma navyaṃ dhiyā syāma rathyaḥ sadāsāḥ ‖ 21 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नु । स्तुतः । इंद्र । नु । गृणानः । इषं । जरित्रे । नद्यः । न । पीपेरिति पीपेः ।
> अकारि । ते । हरिऽवः । ब्रह्म । नव्यं । धिया । स्याम । रथ्यः । सदाऽसाः ॥ २१ ॥

> *nu | stutaḥ | iṃdra | nu | gṛṇānaḥ | iṣaṃ | jaritre | nadyaḥ | na | pīperiti pīpeḥ |*
> *akāri | te | hari 'vaḥ | brahma | navyaṃ | dhiyā | syāma | rathyaḥ | sadā 'sāḥ ‖ 21 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र नु क्षिप्रं स्तुतः पूर्वैर्यषिभिः संस्तुतो नु क्षिप्रंगृणानोऽस्माभिः स्तूयमानश्च त्वमिषमन्नं जरित्रे स्तोत्रे मह्यं नद्यो न अद्भिन्नदीरिव पीपेः । प्यायय । प्रवृद्धं कुरु । हे इंद्र हरिवो हरिवन् हरिसंज्ञकाश्वोपेतेंद्र ते तुभ्यं नव्यं नवतरं ब्रह्म स्तोत्रमकारि । अस्माभिः क्रियते । रथ्यो रथवंतो वयं धिया प्रज्ञारूपया स्तुत्या सदासास्त्वां सर्वदा भजमानास्त्वदर्थं हवीरूपस्यान्नस्य दातारो ना स्याम । भूयास्मै ॥

> *he iṃdra nu kṣipraṃ stutaḥ pūrvairyaṣibhiḥ saṃstuto nu kṣipraṃgr̥ṇāno 'smābhiḥ*
> *stūyamānaśca tvamiṣamannaṃ jaritre stotre mahyaṃ nadyo na adbhinnadīriva pīpeḥ |*
> *pyāyaya | pravr̥ddhaṃ kuru | he iṃdra harivo harivan harisaṃjñakāśvopeteṃdra*
> *te tubhyaṃ navyaṃ navataraṃ brahma stotramakāri | asmābhiḥ kriyate | rathyo rathavaṃto*
> *vayaṃ dhiyā prajñārūpayā stutyā sadāsāstvāṃ sarvadā bhajamānāstvadarthaṃ havīrūpasyānnasya dātāro nā syāma | bhūyāsmai ||*

Summary

O Indra, praised (स्तुतः (*stutaḥ*)) quickly by earlier seers and now being praised by us, fill (पीपेः (*pīpeḥ*)), make abundant, for me the praiser (जरित्रे (*jaritre*)) food (इषं (*iṣaṃ*)), as rivers are filled with waters. O हरिवः (*harivaḥ*), Indra with horses called Hari, a newer (नव्यं (*navyaṃ*)) hymn has been made for you by us. We who own chariots (रथ्यः (*rathyaḥ*)), through praise in the form of insight (धिया (*dhiyā*)), सदासाः (*sadāsāḥ*), constantly serving you, would be givers of food in the form of oblations for you.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नु (*nu*)—quickly (in eagerness to worship you)
- स्तुतः (*stutaḥ*)—praised by the seers of former times
- नु (*nu*)—with the same eagerness in the form of faith
- गृणानः (*gr̥ṇānaḥ*)—and being praised by us
- जरित्रे (*jaritre*)—to me, the praiser
- नद्यो न (*nadyo na*)—as rivers fill with their flow
- इषं (*iṣaṃ*)—food
- पीपेः (*pīpeḥ*)—fill
- हरिवः (*harivaḥ*)—O Indra with horses named Hari
- ते (*te*)—for you
- नव्यं (*navyaṃ*)—new
- ब्रह्म (*brahma*)—hymn

- अकारि (*akāri*)—is made by us
- रथ्यः (*rathyaḥ*)—we who possess chariots
- धिया (*dhiyā*)—by our praise in the form of insight
- सदासाः (*sadāsāḥ*)—offering oblations and the like to you
- स्याम (*syāma*)—grant that we may be

Gist

O Indra, praised by the seers of former times, who were eager to worship you, and now praised by us in the same eager faith, fill me, your praiser, with food as rivers fill with their flow. O Indra with the horses called Hari, we make a new hymn for you. Grant that we, possessors of an excellent chariot, may be, through our hymn of insight, offerers of oblations and the like to you.

English translation

Glorified (in the past), glorified, Indra, at present, satisfy your worshipper with food, as rivers (are filled with water): Lord of horses, a new hymn has been made for you : may we, possessed of chariots, be ever delight-in (your) praise.

Sūkta 17 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यमित्येकविंशत्यृचं सप्तमं सूक्तं । अत्रेयमनुक्रमणिका । त्वं महा
> असिक्कोमेकपदेति । असिक्कां यजमानो न होतेत्येकपदा
> विराट् शिष्टा विंशतिस्त्रिष्टुभः । इंद्रो देवता ॥ समूळ्हे दशरात्रेऽष्टमेऽहनि
> निष्केवल्य इदं सूक्तं विनियुक्तं । तथा च सूत्रितं । त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यमिति
> निष्केवल्यं । आ. ८–७ । इति ॥ इंद्रस्य वृत्रघन्स्वं महा इति पशुपुरोडाशस्यानुवाक्या ।
> सूत्रितं च । त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं ह क्षाः सत्राहणं । आ. ३–८ । इति ॥
> अनुवादवु—त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं ऎंब ई सूक्तवु ऎरडनॆय अनुवाकदल्लि एळनॆय
> सूक्तवु. इदरल्लि इप्पत्तॊंदु ऋक्कुगळिरुववु. ई सूक्तक्कॆ वामदेवनु ऋषियु. अनुक्रमणिकॆ
> यल्लि—त्वं महा असिक्न्यामेकपदा ऎंदु हेळिरुवुदु. ई सूक्तद हदिनैदनॆय ऋक्काद—
> असिक्न्यां यजमानो न होता ऎंब ऋक्कु एकपदा विराट् ऎंब छंदस्सिनदु. उळिद
> इप्पत्तु ऋक्कुगळू त्रिष्टुप्छंदस्कवु. इंद्रनु देवतॆयु, समूळ्वॆंब दशरात्रयागद ऎंट
> नॆय दिवस निष्केवल्यशस्त्रमंत्र पठनक्कागि ई सूक्तद विनियोगविरुवुदॆंदु आश्वलायनशौत
> सूत्रद—त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यमिति निष्केवल्यं ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ. ८–७) विवृतवागिरुवुदु.
> पशुयागदल्लि वृत्रघ्न इंद्रनन्नुद्देशिसि पुरोडाशहोममाडुवाग—त्वं महा ऎंब
> ई ऋक्कन्नु अनुवाक्यामंत्रवन्नागि उपयोगिसबेकॆंदु आश्वलायनशौतसूत्रद—त्वं महा
> इंद्र तुभ्यं ह क्षाः सत्राहणं ऎंब सूत्रदिंद (आ. ३–८) विवृतवागिरुवुदु.

> *tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyamityekaviṃśatyṛcaṃ saptamaṃ sūktaṃ |*
> *atreyamanukramaṇikā | tvaṃ mahā asikkomekapadeti | asikkāṃ yajamāno na hotetyekapadā*
> *virāṭ śiṣṭā viṃśatistriṣṭubhaḥ | iṃdro devatā ‖ samūḷhe daśarātrè 'ṣṭame 'hani*
> *niṣkevalya idaṃ sūktaṃ viniyuktaṃ | tathā ca sūtritaṃ | tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyamiti*
> *niṣkevalyaṃ | ā. 8-7 | iti ‖ iṃdrasya vṛtraghansvaṃ mahā iti paśupuroḍāśasyānuvākyā | sūtritaṃ ca | tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ ha kṣāḥ satrāhaṇaṃ | ā. 3-8 | iti ‖*
> *anuvādavu—tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ èṃba ī sūktavu èraḍanèya anuvākadalli eḷanèya*
> *sūktavu. idaralli ippattòṃdu ṛkkugaḷiruvavu. ī sūktakkè vāmadevanu ṛṣiyu. anukramaṇikè*
> *yalli—tvaṃ mahā asiknyāmekapadā èṃdu heḷiruvudu. ī sūktada*

> *hadinaidanèya ṛkkāda—*
> *asiknyāṃ yajamāno na hotā èṃba ṛkku ekapadā virāṭ èṃba chaṃdassinadu. uḷida*
> *ippattu ṛkkugaḷū triṣṭupchaṃdaskavu. iṃdranu devatèyu, samūḷvèṃba daśarātrayāgada èṃṭa*
> *nèya divasa niṣkevalyaśastramaṃtra paṭhanakkāgi ī sūktada viniyogaviruvudèṃdu āśvalāyanaśauta*
> *sūtrada—tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ èṃba sūtradiṃda (ā. 8-7) vivṛtavāgiruvudu.*
> *paśuyāgadalli vṛtraghna iṃdranannuddeśisi puroḍāśahomamāḍuvāga—tvaṃ mahā èṃba*
> *ī ṛkkannu anuvākyāmaṃtravannāgi upayogisabekèṃdu āśvalāyanaśautasūtrada—tvaṃ mahā*
> *iṃdra tubhyaṃ ha kṣāḥ satrāhaṇaṃ èṃba sūtradiṃda (ā. 3-8) vivṛtavāgiruvudu.*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The sūkta त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ*) has twenty-one ṛks and is the seventh sūkta. The Anukramaṇikā says त्वं महा असिक्कोमेकपदेति (*tvaṃ mahā asikkomekapadeti*): the ṛk असिक्न्यां यजमानो न होता (*asiknyāṃ yajamāno na hotā*) is Ekapadā Virāṭ, and the remaining twenty are Triṣṭubh. The deity is Indra. The sūkta is applied in the Samūḍha Daśarātra, on the eighth day, in the Niṣkevalya. So it is stated in the sūtra: त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यमिति निष्केवल्यं। आ. ८-७। (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ| ā. 8-7|*) (Ā. 8-7). Also the ṛk त्वं महा (*tvaṃ mahā*), referring to Indra's slaying of Vṛtra, is the anuvākyā for the animal-sacrifice puroḍāśa, as in the sūtra त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं ह क्षाः सत्राहणं। आ. ३-८। (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ ha kṣāḥ satrāhaṇaṃ| ā. 3-8|*) (Ā. 3-8).

Anuvāda

The sūkta beginning त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ*) is the seventh sūkta in the second anuvāka. It has twenty-one ṛks. Vāmadeva is its seer. The Anukramaṇikā says त्वं महा असिक्न्यामेकपदा (*tvaṃ mahā asiknyāmekapadā*). The fifteenth ṛk, असिक्न्यां यजमानो न होता (*asiknyāṃ yajamāno na hotā*), is in the metre Ekapadā Virāṭ; the other twenty are Triṣṭubh. Indra is the deity. The Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra, in त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यमिति निष्केवल्यं (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyamiti niṣkevalyaṃ*) (Ā. 8-7), explains the application of the sūkta to the recitation of the Niṣkevalya śastra on the eighth day of the Samūḷha Daśarātra. In the animal sacrifice, when the puroḍāśa offering is made to Indra the Vṛtra-slayer, this ṛk is to be used as the anuvākyā, as explained by the sūtra त्वं महा इंद्र तुभ्यं ह क्षाः सत्राहणं (*tvaṃ mahā iṃdra tubhyaṃ ha kṣāḥ satrāhaṇaṃ*) (Ā. 3-8).

> सूक्त–१७
> मंडल—४ ॥ अनुवाक—२ ॥ सूक्त—१७ ॥
> अष्टक—३ ॥ अध्याय—५ ॥ वर्ग—२१, २२, २३, २४ ॥
> सूक्तदल्लिरुव ऋक्संख्ये—२१ ॥
> ऋषिः—वामदेवः ॥
> देवता—इंद्रः ॥
> छंदः—१–१४, १६–२१. त्रिष्टुप् । १५. एकपदा ।i

> *sūkta-17*
> *maṃḍala—4 ‖ anuvāka—2 ‖ sūkta—17 ‖*
> *aṣṭaka—3 ‖ adhyāya—5 ‖ varga—21, 22, 23, 24 ‖*
> *sūktadalliruva ṛksaṃkhyè—21 ‖*
> *ṛṣi:—vāmadevaḥ ‖*
> *devatā—iṃdraḥ ‖*
> *chaṃdaḥ—1-14, 16-21. triṣṭup | 15. ekapadā li*

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वं म॒हाँ इं॑न्द्र॒ तुभ्यं᳚ ह॒ क्षा अनु॑ क्ष॒त्रं मं॒हना॑ मन्यत॒ द्यौः ।
त्वं वृ॒त्रं शवं॑सा जघ॒न्वान्सृ॒जः सिन्धूँ॒रहिं॑ना जग्रसा॒नान् ॥ १ ॥

> *tvaṃ mahā~ indra tubhyaṃ ha kṣā anu kṣatraṃ maṃhanā manyata dyauḥ |*
> *tvaṃ vṛtraṃ śavasā jaghanvānsṛjaḥ sindhū~rahinā jagrasānān ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । महान् । इंद्र । शुभ्यं । ह । क्षाः । अनु । क्षत्रं । मंहना । मन्यत । द्यौः ।
> त्वं । वृत्रं । शवसा । जघन्वान् । सृजः । सिंधून् । अहिना । जग्रसानान् । १ ॥

> *tvaṃ | mahān | iṃdra | śubhyaṃ | ha | kṣāḥ | anu | kṣatraṃ | maṃhanā | manyata | dyauḥ |*
> *tvaṃ | vṛtraṃ | śavasā | jaghanvān | sṛjaḥ | siṃdhūn | ahinā | jagrasānān | 1 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं महान्प्रभूतो भवसि । क्षाः पृथिवी । क्षा इति पृथिवीनामैतत् । मंहना महत्वेन युक्ता सती तुभ्यं ह त्वदर्थमेव क्षत्रं त्वदीयं बलमनु मन्यत । अन्वमन्यत ! अनुमतीचकार । द्यौश्च त्वदर्थं बलमन्वमन्यत । हे
> इंद्र त्वं शवसा त्वदीयेन बलेन वृत्रं लोकानामावरकं वृत्रनामकमसुरं
> जघन्वान् । हतवान्। किंच अहिना वृत्रेण जग्रसानान् जग्रहाणान् ग्रस्तान्॥ ग्रसतेर्लिटः कानजादेशः ॥ सिंधून् अपः सृजः । असृजः । सृष्टवानसि ॥

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ mahānprabhūto bhavasi | kṣāḥ pṛthivī | kṣā iti pṛthivīnāmaitat | maṃhanā mahatvena yuktā satī tubhyaṃ ha tvadarthameva kṣatraṃ tvadīyaṃ balamanu manyata | anvamanyata ! anumatīcakāra | dyauśca tvadarthaṃ balamanvamanyata | he*
> *iṃdra tvaṃ śavasā tvadīyena balena vṛtraṃ lokānāmāvarakaṃ vṛtranāmakamasuraṃ*
> *jaghanvān | hatavān| kiṃca ahinā vṛtreṇa jagrasānān jagrahāṇān grastān‖ grasaterliṭaḥ kānajādeśaḥ ‖ siṃdhūn apaḥ sṛjaḥ | asṛjaḥ | sṛṣṭavānasi ‖*

Summary

O Indra, you are great. क्षाः (*kṣāḥ*) is the earth (क्षा इति पृथिवीनामैतत् (*kṣā iti pṛthivīnāmaitat*)). The earth, endowed with greatness (मंहना (*maṃhanā*)), has acknowledged your strength (क्षत्रं (*kṣatraṃ*)) for you alone (तुभ्यं ह (*tubhyaṃ ha*)); heaven too has acknowledged your strength. O Indra, you have slain with your vigour (शवसा (*śavasā*))

Vṛtra, the demon who covers the worlds. Moreover, you have released the waters (सिंधून् (*siṃdhūn*)) that had been swallowed (जग्रसानान् (*jagrasānān*)) by Ahi, that is Vṛtra.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- महान् (*mahān*)—are great
- क्षाः (*kṣāḥ*)—the earth
- मंडना (*maṃḍanā*)—although endowed with majesty
- तुभ्यं ह (*tubhyaṃ ha*)—to you (before you)
- क्षत्रं (*kṣatraṃ*)—your strength

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- अनुमन्यत (*anumanyata*)—has acknowledged
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)—heaven also (has acknowledged)
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- शवसा (*śavasā*)—by your strength
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—the demon who covered all the world
- जघन्वान् (*jaghanvān*)—have slain
- अहिना (*ahinā*)—by that same Vṛtra
- जग्रसानान् (*jagrasānān*)—that were obstructed
- सिंधून् (*siṃdhūn*)—the waters
- सृजः (*sṛjaḥ*)—you released and made to flow

Gist

O Indra, you are possessed of exceeding greatness. Even the earth and heaven, themselves endowed with great majesty, have acknowledged before you your strength, as one greater than they. By your power you have slain the demon who covered all the world, and you have released the waters obstructed by Vṛtra and made them flow.

English translation

You, Indra, are mighty; the vast earth confesses to you (your) strength, as do the heaven : you have slain Vritra by your vigour, you have set free the rivers arrested by Ahi.

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

तव॑ त्वि॒षो जनि॑मन्रेजत॒ द्यौ रेज॒द्भूमि॑र्भि॒यसा॒ स्वस्य॑ म॒न्योः ।
ऋ॒घा॒यन्त॑ सु॒भ्व१॒॑ः पर्व॑तास॒ आर्द॒न्धन्वा॑नि स॒रय॑न्त॒ आप॑ः ॥ २ ॥

> *tava tviṣo janimanrejata dyau rejadbhūmirbhiyasā svasya manyoḥ |*
> *ṛghāyanta subhvaḥ parvatāsa ārdandhanvāni sarayanta āpaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> तव । त्विषः । जनिमन् । रेजत । द्याः । रेजत् । भूमिः । भियसा । स्वस्य । मन्योः ।
> ऋघायंत । सुभ्वः । पर्वतासः । आर्दन् । धन्वानि । सरयंते । आपः ॥ २ ॥

> *tava | tviṣaḥ | janiman | rejata | dyāḥ | rejat | bhūmiḥ | bhiyasā | svasya | manyoḥ |*
> *ṛghāyaṃta | subhvaḥ | parvatāsaḥ | ārdan | dhanvāni | sarayaṃte | āpaḥ ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्विषो दीप्यमानस्य तव त्वदीये जनिमन् जन्मनि सति द्यौरंतरिक्षं
> स्वस्य त्वदीयान्मन्योः कोपात् । पंचम्यर्थे षष्ठी । भियसा जातभयेन रेजत ।
> अरेजत् । अकंपत । भूमिश्च रेजत् । कंपमाना बभूव । सुभ्वो महांतः

> *he iṃdra tviṣo dīpyamānasya tava tvadīye janiman janmani sati dyauraṃtarikṣaṃ*
> *svasya tvadīyānmanyoḥ kopāt | paṃcamyarthe ṣaṣṭhī | bhiyasā*

> *jātabhayena rejata |*
> *arejat | akaṃpata | bhūmiśca rejat | kaṃpamānā babhūva | subhvo mahāṃtaḥ*

> पर्वतासः। पर्वता मेघाः। ऋघायंत। सस्यादीनां वृष्टिप्रदानार्थं नियामकेन
> त्वयाबाध्यंत । तथा मेघा आर्दन् । प्राणिनां पिपासारूपां पीडामुहिंसन् ।
> तथा मेघा धन्वान्युदकरहितान्वेशानापोऽपः सरयंते । गमयंति ॥

> *parvatāsaḥ| parvatā meghāḥ| ṛghāyaṃta| sasyādīnāṃ vṛṣṭipradānārthaṃ niyāmakena*
> *tvayābādhyaṃta | tathā meghā ārdan | prāṇināṃ pipāsārūpāṃ pīḍāmuhiṃsan |*
> *tathā meghā dhanvānyudakarahitānveśānāpo 'paḥ sarayaṃte | gamayaṃti ‖*

Summary

O Indra, when you, the shining one (त्विषः (*tviṣaḥ*)), were born (जनिमन् (*janiman*)), heaven, that is the atmosphere, trembled (रेजत (*rejata*)) through fear arisen from your own anger (मन्योः (*manyoḥ*)); the genitive stands in the sense of the ablative. The earth also trembled. The सुभ्वः (*subhvaḥ*), the great ones… (the block breaks off here; the next window continues).

The "mountains" (*parvatas*) are clouds. They were constrained (*ṛghāyanta*) by you, the controller, so that they might give rain to crops and the like. The clouds also "afflicted" (*ārdan*): they destroyed the pain of thirst in living beings. And the clouds make the waters flow (*sarayante*, cause to go) over the arid, waterless regions (*dhanvāni*).

Word-to-word meaning

- (Hail Indra)
- त्विषः (*tviṣaḥ*)—radiant one
- तव (*tava*)—your
- जनिमन् (*janiman*)—at the time of birth
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)—the atmosphere
- स्वस्य (*svasya*)—your
- मन्योः (*manyoḥ*)—(born) of wrath

- भियसा (*bhiyasā*)—through fear
- रेजत (*rejata*)—trembled
- भूमिः (*bhūmiḥ*)—the earth also
- रेजत् (*rejat*)—trembled
- सुभ्वः (*subhvaḥ*)—of mighty form
- पर्वतासः (*parvatāsaḥ*)—the clouds
- ऋघायंत (*ṛghāyaṃta*)—became subject to your control (therefore)
- आर्दन् (*ārdan*)—cooling (the scorched regions)
- धन्वानि (*dhanvāni*)—even in the waterless barren land
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters in the form of rain
- सरयंते (*sarayaṃte*)—they pour down

Gist

O Indra, at the birth of you, the radiant one, the atmosphere trembled with the fear born of your wrath. The earth too shook. The mighty clouds, brought under your control, quench the thirst of living beings and cool the scorched regions, and pour waters in the form of rain even on the waterless barren land.

English translation

At the birth of you who are resplendent, trembled the heaven (and) trembled the earth through fear of your wrath; the mighty clouds were confined ; they destroyed (the distress of drought), spreading the waters over the dry places.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

भि॒नद्गि॒रिं शव॑सा॒ वज्र॑मि॒ष्णन्ना॑विष्कृण्वा॒नः स॑हसा॒न ओजः॑ ।
वधी॑द्वृ॒त्रं वज्रे॑ण मन्दसा॒नः सर॒न्नापो॒ जव॑सा ह॒तवृ॑ष्णीः ॥ ३ ॥

> *bhinadgiriṃ śavasā vajramiṣṇannāviṣkṛṇvānaḥ sahasāna ojaḥ |*
> *vadhīdvṛtraṃ vajreṇa mandasānaḥ sarannāpo javasā hatavṛṣṇīḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> भिनत् । गिरिं । शवसा । वज्रं । इष्णन् । आविःकृण्वानः । सहसाना । ओजः ।
> वधीत् । वृत्रं । वज्रेण । मंदसानः । सरन् । आपः । जवसा । हतवृष्टिः ॥ ३ ॥

> *bhinat | giriṃ | śavasā | vajraṃ | iṣṇan | āviḥkṛṇvānaḥ | sahasānā | ojaḥ |*
> *vadhīt | vṛtraṃ | vajreṇa | maṃdasānaḥ | saran | āpaḥ | javasā | hatavṛṣṭiḥ ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सहसानः शत्रूणामभिभवन्नोजस्तेज आविष्कृण्वान आविष्कुर्वन्निंद्रो वज्रमिष्ठिन् वज्रं प्रेरयन्
> शवसा बलेन गिरिं पर्वतजातं भिनत् । अभिनत् । बिभेद ।
> किंच मंदसानः सोमेन मोदमान इंद्रो वज्रेण वृत्रं वृत्रनामानमसुरं
> वधीत् । अवधीत् । जघान । तत आपो वृत्रेणावृतान्युदकानि हतवृष्टीः । हतो
> वृषा वृत्रो यासां ता हतवृष्ट्यः । ता वृत्रवधानंतरं निवारणरहिताः सत्यो
> जवसा वेगेन सरन् । असरन् । अगच्छन् ॥

> *sahasānaḥ śatrūṇāmabhibhavannojasteja āviṣkṛṇvāna āviṣkurvanniṃdro vajramiṣṭhin vajraṃ prerayan śavasā balena giriṃ parvatajātaṃ bhinat | abhinat | bibheda |*
> *kiṃca maṃdasānaḥ somena modamāna iṃdro vajreṇa vṛtraṃ vṛtranāmānamasuraṃ*
> *vadhīt | avadhīt | jaghāna | tata āpo vṛtreṇāvṛtānyudakāni hatavṛṣṭīḥ | hato*
> *vṛṣā vṛtro yāsāṃ tā hatavṛṣṭyaḥ | tā vṛtravadhānaṃtaraṃ nivāraṇarahitāḥ satyo*
> *javasā vegena saran | asaran | agacchan ‖*

Summary

Indra, overpowering (*sahasānaḥ*) his enemies and manifesting his might (*ojaḥ*), hurling his thunderbolt, split by his strength the mountain (*giri*) born of the cloud (*parvata*). Further, Indra, exhilarated by Soma, slew with the thunderbolt the asura named

Vṛtra. Then the waters, which had been enclosed by Vṛtra, are *hatavṛṣṭīḥ*: those whose bull (*vṛṣā*) Vṛtra was slain. After the killing of Vṛtra they were free of obstruction and flowed (*saran*) swiftly.

Word-to-word meaning

- सहसानः (*sahasānaḥ*)—Indra, the subduer of enemies
- ओजः (*ojaḥ*)—his own splendour
- आविष्कृण्वानः (*āviṣkṛṇvānaḥ*)—manifesting
- वज्रं (*vajraṃ*)—the thunderbolt
- इष्टन् (*iṣṭan*)—hurling
- शवसा (*śavasā*)—by his strength
- गिरिं (*giriṃ*)—the mountain
- भिनत् (*bhinat*)—he split
- मंदसानः (*maṃdasānaḥ*)—Indra, satisfied by drinking Soma
- वज्रेण (*vajreṇa*)—with the thunderbolt
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—the asura called Vṛtra
- वधीत् (*vadhīt*)—he killed (afterwards)
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters
- हतवृष्टिः (*hatavṛṣṭiḥ*)—free of obstruction
- जवसा (*javasā*)—with speed
- सरन् (*saran*)—flowed

Gist

Indra, the subduer of enemies, manifesting his splendour and hurling the thunderbolt, split the mountain by his strength. Indra, satisfied by drinking Soma, slew Vṛtra with the thunderbolt. Then the waters flowed swiftly, free of obstruction.

English translation

The subduer of foes, manifesting his energy and hurling his thunderbolt, shattered the mountain by his strength: he slew Vritra with the thunderbolt, exulting, and the waters whose obstructor was destroyed rushed forth with rapidity.

Ṛk 4

Samhitā-pāṭha

सु॒वीरं॑स्ते जनि॒ता मं॑न्यत॒ द्यौरिन्द्रं॑स्य क॒र्ता स्वपं॑स्तमो भूत् ।
य ईं॑ ज॒जानं॑ स्व॒र्यं॑ सु॒वज्र॒मनं॑पच्युत॒ं सदं॑सो॒ न भूमं॑ ॥ ४ ॥

> *suvīraste janitā manyata dyaurindrasya kartā svapastamo bhūt |*
> *ya īṃ jajāna svaryaṃ suvajramanapacyutaṃ sadaso na bhūma ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सुवीरः । ते । जनिता । मन्यत । द्यौः । इंद्रस्य । कर्ता । स्वपःतमः । भूत् ।
> यः । ईं । जजान 'स्वर्यं । सुवज्रं । अनपच्युतं । सदसः । न । भूम ॥ ४ ॥

> *suvīraḥ | te | janitā | manyata | dyauḥ | iṃdrasya | kartā | svapaḥtamaḥ | bhūt |*
> *yaḥ | īṃ | jajāna 'svaryaṃ | suvajraṃ | anapacyutaṃ | sadasaḥ | na | bhūma ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र यः प्रजापतिः स्वर्यमृत्विगादिभिः स्तुत्यं सुवज्रं शोभनवज्रोपेतं सदसः स्वकीयात्स्वर्गाख्यात्स्थानादनपच्युतं विनाशरहितं च । नेति समुच्चयार्थे । भूम भूम्ना महत्वेन युक्तमीमेनं त्वां जजान । अजीजनत् ॥
> जन जनन इति धातुः ॥ द्यौद्योतमानस्ते तव जनिता जनयिता स प्रजापतिः सुवीरः शोभनपुत्रवानहमस्मिति मन्यत । अमन्यत । किंच इंद्रस्य कर्तृंद्रस्य जनयिता प्रजापतिः स्वपस्तमोऽत्यंतं शोभनकर्माभूत् ॥

> *he iṃdra yaḥ prajāpatiḥ svaryamṛtvigādibhiḥ stutyaṃ suvajraṃ śobhanavajropetaṃ sadasaḥ svakīyātsvargākhyātsthānādanapacyutaṃ vināśarahitaṃ ca | neti samuccayārthe | bhūma bhūmnā mahatvena yuktamīmenaṃ tvāṃ jajāna | ajījanat ‖*
> *jana janana iti dhātuḥ ‖ dyaudyotamānaste tava janitā janayitā sa prajāpatiḥ suvīraḥ*

> *śobhanaputravānahamasmiti manyata | amanyata | kiṃca iṃdrasya kartṛṃdrasya janayitā*
> *prajāpatiḥ svapastamo 'tyaṃtaṃ śobhanakarmābhūt ||*

Summary

O Indra, the Prajāpati who begot you (*jajāna*, "caused to be born"; the root is *jana*, "to be born/beget") is praised (*svarya*) by the priests and the like; he is possessed of a fine thunderbolt (*suvajra*), unfallen (*anapacyuta*) from his own seat called heaven, and indestructible. The word *na* is in the sense of "and" (conjunction). You, Indra, are endowed with greatness (*bhūma*). The shining one (*dyau*), your begetter (*janitā*), that Prajāpati, thought (*manyata*): "I have a fine son (*suvīra*)." Further, the maker (*kartā*) of Indra, the Prajāpati who begot Indra, became (*abhūt*) exceedingly skilled in good works (*svapastama*).

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) यः (*yaḥ*)—which Prajāpati
- स्वर्यं (*svaryaṃ*)—one praised by the priests
- सुवज्रं (*suvajraṃ*)—one endowed with an excellent thunderbolt
- सदसः (*sadasaḥ*)—from his own place, heaven
- अनपच्युतं (*anapacyutaṃ*)—one who suffers no fall
- भूम (*bhūma*)—endowed with greatness
- ईं (*īṃ*)—you, who are Indra
- जजान (*jajāna*)—created; such a one
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*)—the shining one
- ते जनिता (*te janitā*)—your begetter, Prajāpati
- सुवीरः (*suvīraḥ*)—that he had obtained an excellent son
- मन्यत (*manyata*)—understood
- इंद्रस्य (*iṃdrasya*)—of Indra
- कर्ता (*kartā*)—the begetter, Prajāpati
- स्वपस्तमः (*svapastamaḥ*)—as the doer of an excellent work
- भूत् (*bhūt*)—he became

Gist

O Indra, the Prajāpati who created you, Indra, who are praised by the priests, endowed with an excellent thunderbolt, without fall from your own place, heaven, and endowed with greatness—that shining Prajāpati, your begetter, understood that he had obtained an excellent son. Prajāpati, the begetter of Indra, became the doer of an excellent work.

English translation

Heaven, your progenitor, conceived (I have obtained) a worthy son; the maker of Indra was the accomplisher of a most excellent work; he who begot the adorable (Indra), armed with the thunderbolt, irremovable from his station, and endowed with greatness.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

य एक॑ इच्च्या॒वय॑ति॒ प्र भू॒मा राजा॑ कृ॒ष्टी॒नां पु॑रुहू॒त इन्द्र॑ः ।
स॒त्यमे॑न॒मनु॒ विश्वे॑ मदन्ति रा॒तिं दे॒वस्य॑ गृ॒ण॒तो म॒घोन॑ः ॥ ५ ॥

> *ya eka iccyāvayati pra bhūmā rājā kṛṣṭīnāṃ puruhūta indraḥ |*
> *satyamenamanu viśve madanti rātiṃ devasya gṛṇato maghonaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> यः । एकः । इत् । च्यवयति । प्र । भूम । राजा । कृष्टीनां । पुरुहूतः । इंद्रः ।
> सत्यं । एनं । अनु । विश्वे । मदंति । रातिं । देवस्य । गृणतः । मघोनः ॥ ५ ॥

> *yaḥ | ekaḥ | it | cyavayati | pra | bhūma | rājā | kṛṣṭīnāṃ | puruhūtaḥ | iṃdraḥ |*
> *satyaṃ | enaṃ | anu | viśve | madaṃti | rātiṃ | devasya | gṛṇataḥ | maghonaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> कृष्णीनां सर्वासां प्रजानां राजा प्रभुः पुरुहूतो बहुभिराहूत एक
> इद्देवानां मध्यॆ मुख्य एव य इंद्रो भूम भूतं निष्पन्नं शत्रुभ्यो भयं प्र
> च्यावयति । प्रकर्षेण नाशयति । विश्वे सर्वॆ यजमाना मघोनो मघवतः ।
> हनिर्लक्षणधनवत इत्यर्थः । देवस्येंद्रसमाश्रयात् द्योतमानस्य गृणतः स्तुवतो
> रातिं बंधुमेनमिंद्रमनु लक्ष्मीकृत्य सत्यमेव नदंति । स्तुवंति ॥

> *kṛṣṇīnāṃ sarvāsāṃ prajānāṃ rājā prabhuḥ puruhūto bahubhirāhūta eka*
> *iddevānāṃ madhyè mukhya eva ya iṃdro bhūma bhūtaṃ niṣpannaṃ śatrubhyo bhayaṃ pra*
> *cyāvayati | prakarṣeṇa nāśayati | viśve sarvè yajamānā maghono maghavataḥ |*
> *hanirlakṣaṇadhanavata ityarthaḥ | devasyeṃdrasamāśrayāt dyotamānasya gṛṇataḥ stuvato*
> *rātiṃ baṃdhumenamiṃdramanu lakṣmīkṛtya satyameva nadaṃti | stuvaṃti ‖*

Summary

Indra is the king, the lord of all subjects (*kṛṣṭi*), invoked by many (*puruhūta*), alone (*eka it*) the chief among the gods. He utterly destroys (*pra cyāvayati*) the *bhūma*, the fear that has arisen from enemies. All sacrificers, *maghonaḥ*, that is, wealthy, possessed of wealth characterised by oblation, aiming at (*anu*) this Indra, who is the friend (*rāti*, "bandhu") of the shining (*devasya*, through resorting to Indra) praiser (*gṛṇataḥ*), verily praise him (he reads *nadanti*, "they praise").[?460]

Word-to-word meaning

- कृष्णीनां (*kṛṣṇīnāṃ*)—of all subjects
- राजा (*rājā*)—the lord
- पुरुहूतः (*puruhūtaḥ*)—one invoked by many
- एक इत् (*eka it*)—chief of all gods, men and the rest
- यः इंद्रः (*yaḥ iṃdraḥ*)—which Indra
- भूम (*bhūma*)—the fear arising from enemies
- प्र च्यावयति (*pra cyāvayati*)—destroys; such a one
- मघोनः (*maghonaḥ*)—possessing wealth in the form of oblations

- देवस्य (*devasya*)—shining
- गृणतः (*gṛṇataḥ*)—to the praiser
- रातिं (*rātiṃ*)—a friend
- एनं अनु (*enaṃ anu*)—aiming at this Indra
- सत्यं (*satyaṃ*)—in truth
- विश्वे (*viśve*)—all sacrificers too
- मदंति (*madaṃti*)—praise

Gist

All sacrificers praise in truth this Indra, who is lord of all subjects, invoked by many, chief of all gods, men and the rest, who destroys the fear arisen from enemies, and who is a friend to the praiser, who is shining and possesses wealth in the form of oblations.

English translation

All men, praising the munificence of the divine Maghavan, verily glorify him who alone casts down many, Indra, the king of men, the adored of many.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒त्रा सोमा॑ अभवन्नस्य॒ विश्वे॑ स॒त्रा मदा॑सो बृ॒हतो मदि॑ष्ठाः ।
स॒त्राभ॑वो॒ वसु॑पति॒र्वसू॑ना॒ं द॒त्रे विश्वा॑ अधिथा इन्द्र कृ॒ष्टीः ॥ ६ ॥

> *satrā somā abhavannasya viśve satrā madāso bṛhato madiṣṭhāḥ |*
> *satrābhavo vasupatirvasūnāṃ datre viśvā adhithā indra kṛṣṭīḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सत्रा । सोमाः । अभवन् । अस्य । विश्वे । सत्रा । मदासः । बृहतः । मदिष्टाः ।
> सत्रा । अभवः । वसुपतिः । वसूनां । दत्ते । विश्वाः । अधिथाः । इंद्र । कृष्टीः ॥ ६ ॥

> *satrā | somāḥ | abhavan | asya | viśve | satrā | madāsaḥ | bṛhataḥ | madiṣṭāḥ |*
> *satrā | abhavaḥ | vasupatiḥ | vasūnāṃ | datte | viśvāḥ | adhithāḥ | iṃdra | kṛṣṭīḥ ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> विश्वे सर्वे सोमा अस्येंद्रस्य सत्रा । सत्रेति सत्यनामैतत् । सत्यमेव
> प्रभूता अभवन् । किंच मदासो मदा मदकराः सोमा बृहतो महतोऽस्येंद्रस्य मदिष्टा
> मादयितृतमाः सत्रा सत्यमेवाभवन् । हे इंद्र त्वं वसुपतिर्धनपतिः । न केवलं धनपतिः किंतु
> वसूनां सर्वेषां पश्वादीनां धनानां पतिः सत्रा
> सत्यमेवाभवः । भवसि । हे इंद्र त्वं दत्ते धने निमित्तभूते सति विश्वाः सर्वाः
> कृष्टीः स्तोत्रिः प्रजा अधिथाः । धारयसि ॥

> *viśve sarvè somā asyeṃdrasya satrā | satreti satyanāmaitat | satyameva*
> *prabhūtā abhavan | kiṃca madāso madā madakarāḥ somā bṛhato*
> *mahato 'syeṃdrasya madiṣṭā mādayitṛtamāḥ satrā satyamevābhavan |*
> *he iṃdra tvaṃ vasupatirdhanapatiḥ | na kevalaṃ dhanapatiḥ kiṃtu*
> *vasūnāṃ sarveṣāṃ paśvādīnāṃ dhanānāṃ patiḥ satrā*
> *satyamevābhavaḥ | bhavasi | he iṃdra tvaṃ datte dhane nimittabhūte*
> *sati viśvāḥ sarvāḥ*
> *kṛṣṭīḥ stotriḥ prajā adhithāḥ | dhārayasi ‖*

Summary

All the Soma-offerings of this Indra were truly (*satrā*; he says "*satrā*" is a name for truth) abundant. Further, the intoxicating (*madāsaḥ*) Soma-offerings were truly the most exhilarating (*madiṣṭhāḥ*) to the great Indra. O Indra, you are lord of wealth (*vasupati*); not only lord of wealth, but truly lord of all *vasu*, all riches such as cattle. O Indra, when wealth is given as the cause, you uphold (*adhithāḥ*, "you support") all the subjects (*kṛṣṭi*), the praising people.

Word-to-word meaning

- विश्वे (*viśve*)—all
- सोमाः (*somāḥ*)—the Soma-offerings
- सत्रा (*satrā*)—truly
- अस्य (*asya*)—belonging to Indra alone
- अभवन् (*abhavan*)—became

- मदासः (*madāsaḥ*)—the intoxicating Soma-offerings
- बृहतः (*bṛhataḥ*)—to Indra, of mighty form
- मदिष्टाः (*madiṣṭāḥ*)—as satisfying
- सत्रा (*satrā*)—truly they became
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- (त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you)
- वसुपतिः (*vasupatiḥ*)—as lord of wealth
- वसूनां (*vasūnāṃ*)—as lord also of all riches in the form of cattle and the like
- सत्रा (*satrā*)—truly
- अभवः (*abhavaḥ*)—you are
- दत्ते (*datte*)—by reason of wealth (by giving)
- विश्वाः कृष्टीः (*viśvāḥ kṛṣṭīḥ*)—all the subjects
- अधिथाः (*adhithāḥ*)—you have upheld
- अध (*adha*)—and
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- जायमानः (*jāyamānaḥ*)—having been born
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—at the very beginning
- अमे (*ame*)—when the fear caused by Vṛtra arose
- विश्वाः (*viśvāḥ*)—all

Gist

All the Soma-offerings truly became Indra's own. The intoxicating Soma-offerings truly became satisfying to the mighty Indra. O Indra, you are lord of wealth and lord of all wealth in the form of cattle and the like. By the giving of wealth you uphold all subjects (you nourish them).

English translation

Truly are all libations his; the inebriating draughts are truly most exhilarating to the mighty Indra : truly are you the lord of wealth, of (all sorts of) treasures : you, Indra, support all people by the gift (of riches).

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्वमध॑ प्रथ॒मं जाय॑मा॒नोऽमे॒ विश्वा॑ अधिथा इन्द्र कृ॒ष्टीः ।
त्वं प्रति॑ प्र॒वत॑ आ॒शया॑न॒महिं॒ वज्रे॑ण मघव॒न्वि वृ॑श्चः ॥ ७ ॥

> *tvamadha prathamaṃ jāyamāno 'me viśvā adhithā indra kṛṣṭīḥ |*
> *tvaṃ prati pravata āśayānamahiṃ vajreṇa maghavanvi vṛścaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्वं । अध । प्रथमं । जायमानः । अमे । विश्वाः । अधिथाः । इंद्र । कृष्टीः ।
> त्वं । प्रति । प्रवतः । आशयानं । अहिं । वज्रेण । मघुवन् । वि । वृश्चः ॥ ७ ॥

> *tvaṃ | adha | prathamaṃ | jāyamānaḥ | ame | viśvāḥ | adhithāḥ | iṃdra | kṛṣṭīḥ |*
> *tvaṃ | prati | pravataḥ | āśayānaṃ | ahiṃ | vajreṇa | maghuvan | vi | vṛścaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अध अपि च प्रथममेव जायमानस्त्वममे वृत्रनिमित्ते भये सति विश्वाः
> सर्वाः कृष्टीः प्रजा अधिथाः । रक्षकत्वेन धारयसि । हे मघवन्थनवन्निंद्र त्वं प्रति
> प्रवतः प्रति प्रवणानुदकवतो देशान् लक्ष्मीकृत्याशयानमपां निरोधकमहिं
> वृत्रनामानमसुरं वज्रेण वि वृश्चः । व्यवृश्च ॥ छिन्नवानसि ॥

> *adha api ca prathamameva jāyamānastvamame vṛtranimitte bhaye sati viśvāḥ*
> *sarvāḥ kṛṣṭīḥ prajā adhithāḥ | rakṣakatvena dhārayasi | he maghavanthanavanniṃdra tvaṃ prati*
> *pravataḥ prati pravaṇānudakavato deśān lakṣmīkṛtyāśayānamapāṃ nirodhakamahiṃ*
> *vṛtranāmānamasuraṃ vajreṇa vi vṛścaḥ | vyavṛśca ‖ chinnavānasi ‖*

Summary

Adha means "and also". As soon as you were born, when there was fear because of Vṛtra (*ame*), you upheld (*adhithāḥ*) all the subjects (*kṛṣṭi*) as their protector. O Maghavan, wealthy Indra, you, aiming at the regions where the water runs downward (*pratipravataḥ*), cut with the thunderbolt Ahi, the asura named Vṛtra, who lay (*āśayānam*) blocking the waters.

Word-to-word meaning

- अध (*adha*)—and
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- जायमानः (*jāyamānaḥ*)—being born
- प्रथमं (*prathamaṃ*)—at the very beginning
- अमे (*ame*)—when fear caused by Vṛtra arose
- विश्वाः (*viśvāḥ*)—all
- कृष्टीः (*kṛṣṭīḥ*)—the subjects
- अधिथाः (*adhithāḥ*)—you have upheld for their protection
- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- प्रति प्रवतः (*prati pravataḥ*)—across the regions of flowing water
- आशयानं (*āśayānaṃ*)—who lay obstructing
- अहिं (*ahiṃ*)—Vṛtra
- वज्रेण (*vajreṇa*)—with the thunderbolt weapon
- निवृश्चः (*nivṛścaḥ*)—you have cut down

Gist

O Indra, as soon as you were born, you took under your protection all the subjects who were distressed by fear caused by Vṛtra. O wealthy Indra, you cut with the thunderbolt Vṛtra who lay blocking the flowing waterways.

English translation

Indra, as soon as you were born, you took the progeny who were afraid of Vritra under your protection. O Maghavan, you smote with your thunderbolt, Ahi, who was obstructing the flow of waters.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒त्रा॒हणं॒ दाधृ॑षिं॒ तुम्र॒मिन्द्रं॑ म॒हाम॑पा॒रं वृ॑ष॒भं सु॒वज्रं॑म् ।
हन्ता॒ यो वृ॒त्रं सनिं॑तो॒त वाजं॒ दाता॑ म॒घानिं॑ म॒घवा॑ सु॒राधा॑◌ः ॥ ८ ॥

> *satrāhaṇaṃ dādhṛṣiṃ tumramindraṃ mahāmapāraṃ vṛṣabhaṃ suvajram |*
> *hantā yo vṛtraṃ sanitota vājaṃ dātā maghāni maghavā surādhāḥ ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सत्राहनं । दधृषिं । तुम्रं । इंद्रं । महां । अपारं । वृषभं । सुवज्रं ।
> हंता । यः । वृत्रं । सनिता । उत । वाजं । दाता । मघानि । मघवा । सुराधाः॥

> *satrāhanaṃ | dadhṛṣiṃ | tumraṃ | iṃdraṃ | mahāṃ | apāraṃ | vṛṣabhaṃ | suvajraṃ |*
> *haṃtā | yaḥ | vṛtraṃ | sanitā | uta | vājaṃ | dātā | maghāni | maghavā | surādhāḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंद्रस्य वृत्रघ्नः पशौ सत्राहणमिति हविषोऽनुवाक्या । सूत्रितं च । सत्राहणं दादृषिं तुम्रमिंद्रं सहदानुं पुरुहूत क्षियंतं । आ. ३.८ । इति ॥

> *iṃdrasya vṛtraghnaḥ paśau satrāhaṇamiti haviṣo 'nuvākyā | sūtritaṃ ca | satrāhaṇaṃ dādṛṣiṃ tumramiṃdraṃ sahadānuṃ puruhūta kṣiyaṃtaṃ | ā. 3.8 | iti ‖*

> सत्राहणं बहूनां शत्रूणां हंतारं दाधृषिमत्यंतं धर्षकं तुम्रं ।
> तुमिः प्रेरणकर्मा । शत्रूणां प्रेरकं महां महांतमपारमपरिमाणं । विनाशरहितमित्यर्थः । वृषभं कामानां वर्षितारं सुवज्रं शोभनेन वज्रेणोपेतमिंद्रं । वयं स्तोतारः स्तुमेति शेषः । य इंद्रो वृत्रं वृत्रनामानमसुरं
> हंता हिंसिता भवति । उतापि च य इंद्रो वाजमन्नं सनिता दाता भवति ।
> सुराधाः शोभनधनयुक्तो यो मघवेंद्रो मघानि धनानि दाता भवति ।
> तमिंद्रं स्तुमेति पूर्णेन्वयः ॥ अत्र सर्वत्र तृनंतत्वान्न लोकाव्ययेति षष्ठीप्रतिषेधे सति द्वितीयैव भवति ॥

> *satrāhaṇaṃ bahūnāṃ śatrūṇāṃ haṃtāraṃ dādhṛṣimatyaṃtaṃ dharṣakaṃ tumraṃ |*
> *tumiḥ preraṇakarmā | śatrūṇāṃ prerakaṃ mahāṃ mahāṃtamapāramaparimāṇaṃ | vināśarahitamityarthaḥ | vṛṣabhaṃ kāmānāṃ varṣitāraṃ suvajraṃ śobhanena vajreṇopetamiṃdraṃ | vayaṃ stotāraḥ stumeti śeṣaḥ | ya iṃdro vṛtraṃ vṛtranāmānamasuraṃ*
> *haṃtā hiṃsitā bhavati | utāpi ca ya iṃdro vājamannaṃ sanitā dātā bhavati |*
> *surādhāḥ śobhanadhanayukto yo maghaveṃdro maghāni dhanāni dātā bhavati |*
> *tamiṃdraṃ stumeti pūrṇenvayaḥ || atra sarvatra tṛnaṃtatvānna lokāvyayeti ṣaṣṭhīpratiṣedhe sati dvitīyaiva bhavati ||*

Summary

In the animal sacrifice to Indra as Vṛtra-slayer, "सत्राहणं (*satrāhaṇaṃ*)" is the anuvākyā of the oblation. It is also stated in the sūtra: सत्राहणं दादृषिं तुम्रमिंद्रं सहदानुं पुरुहूत क्षियंतं । आ. ३.८ । इति ॥ (*satrāhaṇaṃ dādṛṣiṃ tumramiṃdraṃ sahadānuṃ puruhūta kṣiyaṃtaṃ | ā. 3.8 | iti ||*) (Ā. 3.8).

Sāyaṇa glosses सत्राहणं (*satrāhaṇaṃ*) as the slayer of many enemies; दाधृषिं (*dādhṛṣiṃ*) as the extremely bold one, the assailant; तुम्रं (*tumraṃ*) as the impeller of enemies, since the root तुमिः (*tumiḥ*) has the sense of impelling. महां (*mahāṃ*) means great, and अपारं (*apāraṃ*) unmeasured, that is, free from destruction. *kṛṣabhaṃ* is not in the text; वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*) means the showerer of desires, and सुवज्रं (*suvajraṃ*) Indra endowed with a fine thunderbolt. "We, the praisers, praise" is the word to be supplied. He who is the slayer of Vṛtra, the asura of that name, and he who is the giver of वाजं (*vājaṃ*), food;

सुराधाः (*surādhāḥ*) means endowed with fine wealth; and Maghavan Indra is the giver of riches. "We praise that Indra" completes the construction. Throughout, because the words end in the affix tṛn, the genitive is barred and only the accusative occurs.

Word-to-word meaning

- सत्राहणं (*satrāhaṇaṃ*)—the destroyer of many enemies
- दाधृषिं (*dādhṛṣiṃ*)—the subduer of enemies
- तुम्रं (*tumraṃ*)—the harmer of enemies
- महां (*mahāṃ*)—the great one
- अपारं (*apāraṃ*)—the one without limit
- वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—the showerer of desires
- सुवज्रं (*suvajraṃ*)—the one endowed with the excellent thunderbolt (and)
- यं (*yaṃ*)—who
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—Vṛtra
- हंता (*haṃtā*)—has destroyed
- उत (*uta*)—and
- (यः (*yaḥ*)—who)
- वाजं (*vājaṃ*)—to food
- सनिता (*sanitā*)—is the giver; such a one
- सुराधाः (*surādhāḥ*)—endowed with excellent wealth
- (यः (*yaḥ*)) मघवा (*maghavā*)—(which) Indra
- मघानि (*maghāni*)—riches
- दाता (*dātā*)—gives; such a one
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra (we shall praise)

Gist

We shall praise Indra, who has destroyed many enemies, subdues enemies, harms enemies, is without limit, showers desires, is endowed with the excellent thunderbolt, destroys Vṛtra, gives food, and, being endowed with excellent wealth, gives riches.

English translation

(We praise) the slayer of many foes, the courageous, the discomfiter (of enemies), the great, the unbounded, the showerer (of benefits), the wielder of the bright thunderbolt, him who is the destroyer of Vritra, the bestower of food, the giver of wealth, Maghavan the possessor of riches .

Special Topics

In the animal sacrifice offered to Indra the Vṛtra-slayer, when the oblation is offered, this Ṛk beginning सत्राहणं (*satrāhaṇaṃ*) is to be used as the Anuvākyā mantra. This is set out in the Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra by the sūtra सत्राहणं दाधृषिं तुम्रमिंद्रं सहदानुं पुरुहूत क्षियंतं (*satrāhaṇaṃ dādhṛṣiṃ tumramiṃdraṃ sahadānuṃ puruhūta kṣiyaṃtaṃ*) (Ā. 3-8).

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं वृत॑श्चातयते समी॒चीर्य आ॒जिषु॑ म॒घवा॑ शृ॒ण्व एक॑◌ः ।
अ॒यं वाजं॑ भरति॒ यं स॒नोत्य॒स्य प्रि॒यास॑◌ः स॒ख्ये स्या॑म ॥ ९ ॥

> *ayaṃ vṛtaścātayate samīcīrya ājiṣu maghavā śṛṇva ekaḥ |*
> *ayaṃ vājaṃ bharati yaṃ sanotyasya priyāsaḥ sakhye syāma ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । वृतः । चातयते । संईचीः। यः । आजिषु । मघना । शृण्वे । एकः ।
> अयं । वाजं । भरति । यं । सनोति । अस्य । प्रियासः । सख्ये । स्याम ॥ ९ ॥

> *ayaṃ | vṛtaḥ | cātayate | saṃīcīḥ| yaḥ | ājiṣu | maghanā | śṛṇve | ekaḥ |*
> *ayaṃ | vājaṃ | bharati | yaṃ | sanoti | asya | priyāsaḥ | sakhye | syāma ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मघवा धनवान्य इंद्रआजिषु संग्रामेष्वेको मुख्य एव शृण्वे । श्रूयते।
> अयमिंद्रः सविाचीः संगता वृतः । वृण्वंत्याच्छादयंति लोकानिति वृतः शत्रुसेनाः ।
> ताश्चातयते । नाशयति । अयमिंद्रो यं वाजं यदन्नं सनोति ।
> यजमानाय ददाति । तं वाजं भरति । यजमानस्य तवन्नं दातुं बिभर्ति ।
> स्तोतारो वयमस्यॆवंभूतस्येंद्रस्य सख्ये सखत्वे प्रियासः प्रियाः स्याम ।
> भवेनु ॥

> *maghavā dhanavānya iṃdraājiṣu saṃgrāmeṣveko mukhya eva śṛṇve | śrūyate|*
> *ayamiṃdraḥ saviācīḥ saṃgatā vṛtaḥ | vṛṇvaṃtyācchādayaṃti lokāniti vṛtaḥ śatrusenāḥ | tāścātayate | nāśayati | ayamiṃdro yaṃ vājaṃ yadannaṃ sanoti |*
> *yajamānāya dadāti | taṃ vājaṃ bharati | yajamānasya tavannaṃ dātuṃ bibharti |*
> *stotāro vayamasyèvaṃbhūtasyeṃdrasya sakhye sakhatve priyāsaḥ priyāḥ syāma |*
> *bhavenu ‖*

Summary

Maghavan, the wealthy Indra, is heard of as the one chief in battles. This Indra destroys the assembled वृतः (*vṛtaḥ*); वृतः (*vṛtaḥ*) are the enemy armies, because they cover (*vṛṇvaṃti*) the worlds. He destroys them. The food that this Indra bestows on the sacrificer, that food he bears, that is, he carries it to give it to the sacrificer. We, the praisers, may we be dear in the friendship of this Indra, such as he is. "May we be" is the sense.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवा (*maghavā*)—the wealthy
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Indra
- आजिषु (*ājiṣu*)—in battles
- एकः (*ekaḥ*)—as the one chief leader
- शृण्वे (*śṛṇve*)—is renowned
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—that same Indra
- समीचीः (*samīcīḥ*)—that are gathered together

- वृतः (*vṛtaḥ*)—the enemy armies
- चातयते (*cātayate*)—destroys
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this same Indra
- यं वाजं (*yaṃ vājaṃ*)—what food
- सनोति (*sanoti*)—he gives to the sacrificer
- भरति (*bharati*)—(that) he holds ready to bestow
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this Indra
- सख्ये (*sakhye*)—by reason of friendship
- प्रियासः (*priyāsaḥ*)—dear to him
- स्याम (*syāma*)—may we be

Gist

That Indra, the wealthy, who is renowned in battles as the one chief leader, destroys the enemy armies that are gathered together. The very food that this Indra gives to the sacrificer, that he holds ready to bestow on him. By reason of the friendship of this Indra, may we be dear to him.

English translation

This Maghavan, who destroys assembled hosts, is he who is renowned as chief in battles : he brings the food which he bestows (upon the worship- per) : may we be held dear in his friendship.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं शृ॑ण्वे॒ अध॒ जय॑न्नु॒त घ्नन्न॒यमु॒त प्र कृ॑णुते यु॒धा गाः ।
य॒दा स॒त्यं कृ॑णु॒ते म॒न्युमिन्द्रो॒ विश्वं᳚ दृ॒ळ्हं भ॑यत॒ एज॑दस्मात् ॥ १० ॥

> *ayaṃ śṛṇve adha jayannuta ghnannayamuta pra kṛṇute yudhā gāḥ |*
> *yadā satyaṃ kṛṇute manyumindro viśvaṃ dṛḷhaṃ bhayata ejadasmāt ‖*
> *10 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । शृण्वे । अध । जयन् । उत । घ्नन् । अयं । उत । प्र । कृणुते । युधा।
> गाः ।
> यदा । सत्यं । कृणुते । मन्युं । इंद्रः । विश्वं । दृळं । भयते । एजत् । अस्मात्॥

> *ayaṃ | śṛṇve | adha | jayan | uta | ghnan | ayaṃ | uta | pra | kṛṇute | yudhā|*
> *gāḥ |*
> *yadā | satyaṃ | kṛṇute | manyuṃ | iṃdraḥ | viśvaṃ | dṛḷaṃ | bhayate | ejat | asmāt‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अधापि च अयमिंद्रो जयन् शत्रुन्विजयन् शृण्वे । श्रूयते । सर्वत्र
> प्रख्यातो भवति । उतापि च घ्नन् शत्रुन्हिंसन् सर्वत्र श्रूयते । उतापि चायमिंद्रो युधा यद्धेन
> गाः पशून्पृ कृणुते । शत्रुसकाशादाहरति । किंच इंद्रो
> यदा मन्युं कोपं सत्यमेव कृणुते । द्विषदर्थं करोति । तदानीं दृढं स्थिरं
> स्थावररूपमेजत्कंपमानं जंगमरूपं च विश्वं समस्तं जगदस्मादिंद्राध्वयते ।
> बिभेति ॥

> *adhāpi ca ayamiṃdro jayan śatrunvijayan śṛṇve | śrūyate | sarvatra*
> *prakhyāto bhavati | utāpi ca ghnan śatrunhiṃsan sarvatra śrūyate |*
> *utāpi cāyamiṃdro yudhā yaddhena gāḥ paśūnpṛ kṛṇute |*
> *śatrusakāśādāharati | kiṃca iṃdro*
> *yadā manyuṃ kopaṃ satyameva kṛṇute | dviṣadarthaṃ karoti | tadānīṃ*
> *dṛḍhaṃ sthiraṃ*
> *sthāvararūpamejatkaṃpamānaṃ jaṃgamarūpaṃ ca viśvaṃ samastaṃ*
> *jagadasmādiṃdrādhvayate |*
> *bibheti ‖*

Summary

Moreover this Indra, conquering enemies, is heard of, that is, is famed everywhere; and slaying enemies he is heard of everywhere. This Indra also by battle (युधा (*yudhā*)) takes गाः (*gāḥ*), cattle: he carries them off from the enemy's possession. Further, when Indra makes his anger (मन्युं (*manyuṃ*)) true, that is, acts for the sake of the foe, then the whole world, firm, that is, of stationary form, and एजत् (*ejat*), trembling, that is, of moving form, fears this Indra.

Word-to-word meaning

- अध (*adha*)—and
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this Indra
- जयन् (*jayan*)—in conquering the enemy (as victorious)
- शृण्वे (*śṛṇve*)—is renowned
- उत (*uta*)—and
- घ्नन् (*ghnan*)—he is renowned also as the destroyer of enemies
- उत (*uta*)—and
- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this Indra
- युधा (*yudhā*)—by battle
- गाः (*gāḥ*)—cows
- प्र कृणुते (*pra kṛṇute*)—carries them off from the enemies
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- यदा (*yadā*)—when
- मन्युं (*manyuṃ*)—anger
- सत्यं कृणुते (*satyaṃ kṛṇute*)—he makes manifest in truth (then)
- दृळं (*dṛḷaṃ*)—that which is immovably firm
- एजत् (*ejat*)—and that which is of moving nature
- विश्वं (*viśvaṃ*)—the whole world, consisting of the stationary and the moving
- अस्मात् (*asmāt*)—from this Indra
- भयते (*bhayate*)—is seized with fear

Gist

This Indra is renowned at the time of battle as the conqueror of the enemy and the destroyer of enemies. And Indra fights and carries off cattle from the enemies. When this Indra manifests his anger in truth, then the whole world, both what is immovably firm and what is of moving nature, is seized with fear of this Indra.

English translation

This (Indra), is renowned, whether conquering or slaying (his foes), or whether in conflict he recovers the cattle : when Indra truly entertains anger, all that is stationary or moveable is in fear of him. voho2

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

समिन्द्रो॒ गा अ॑जय॒त्सं हिर॑ण्या॒ सम॑श्वि॒या म॒घवा॒
यो ह॑ पू॒र्वीः ।
ए॒भिर्नृभि॒र्नृत॑मो अस्य शा॒कै रा॒यो वि॑भ॒क्ता सं॑म्भ॒रश्च॒
वस्व॑◌ः ॥ ११ ॥

> *samindro gā ajayatsaṃ hiraṇyā samaśviyā maghavā yo ha pūrvīḥ |*
> *ebhirnṛbhirnṛtamo asya śākai rāyo vibhaktā sambharaśca vasvaḥ ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सं । इंद्रः । गाः । अजयत् । सं । हिरण्या । सं । अश्विया । मघवा । यः । ह ।
> पूर्वीः ।
> एभिः । नृभिः । नृतमः । अस्य । शाकैः । रायः । विभक्ता । संभरः । च । वस्वः ॥११॥

> *saṃ | iṃdraḥ | gāḥ | ajayat | saṃ | hiraṇyā | saṃ | aśviyā | maghavā |*
> *yaḥ | ha |*
> *pūrvīḥ |*
> *ebhiḥ | nṛbhiḥ | nṛtamaḥ | asya | śākaiḥ | rāyaḥ | vibhaktā |*
> *saṃbharaḥ | ca | vasvaḥ ‖11‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यो ह यः खलु मघवा धनवानिंद्रोगा असुराणां समजयत् । सम्मक्
> जितवान् भवति । किंच हिरण्या हिरण्यानि हितरमणीयानि शत्रुसंबंधीनि धनानि समअ. ३.
> ५. व. २३] ऋग्वेदसंहिता 97i
> यत् । तथा अश्वियाश्वियानि शत्रुसंबंधिनोऽश्वसमूहान् सम्यक् जयति स्म ।
> तथा पूर्विर्बह्वीः शत्रुसेनाः समजयत् । इंद्रः सर्वान् शत्रून् जित्वा सकलमपि

> पश्वादिधनमपहृतवानित्यर्थः । शाकैः सामर्थ्य्यन्नृतमो नेतृतमः पश्वादीनामतिशयेन निर्वाहकः
> स इंद्र एभिन्नृभिर्नेतृभिः स्तोतृभिः स्तुतः सन् अस्य रायः
> पश्वादिरूपस्य धनस्य विभक्ता स्तोतृभ्यो विभागस्य कर्ता । दाता भवतीत्यर्थः । किंच
> वस्वो वसुनो धनस्य संभरश्च संभर्ता धारकश्च भवति ॥

> *yo ha yaḥ khalu maghavā dhanavāniṃdrogā asurāṇāṃ samajayat | sammak*
> *jitavān bhavati | kiṃca hiraṇyā hiraṇyāni hitaramaṇīyāni*
> *śatrusaṃbaṃdhīni dhanāni samaa. 3. 5. va. 23] ṛgvedasaṃhitā 97i*
> *yat | tathā aśviyāśviyāni śatrusaṃbaṃdhino 'śvasamūhān samyak jayati sma |*
> *tathā pūrvirbahvīḥ śatrusenāḥ samajayat | iṃdraḥ sarvān śatrūn jitvā sakalamapi*
> *paśvādidhanamapahṛtavānityarthaḥ | śākaiḥ sāmarthyyanrṛtamo*
> *netṛtamaḥ paśvādīnāmatiśayena nirvāhakaḥ sa iṃdra*
> *ebhinnṛbhirnetṛbhiḥ stotṛbhiḥ stutaḥ san asya rāyaḥ*
> *paśvādirūpasya dhanasya vibhaktā stotṛbhyo vibhāgasya kartā | dātā bhavatītyarthaḥ | kiṃca*
> *vasvo vasuno dhanasya saṃbharaśca saṃbhartā dhārakaśca bhavati ||*

Summary

Maghavan, the wealthy Indra, who has fully conquered the गाः (*gāḥ*), the cattle of the asuras. हिरण्या (*hiraṇyā*) are हिरण्यानि (*hiraṇyāni*), wealth that is beneficial and delightful, belonging to the enemy; these he conquered completely. Likewise अश्विया (*aśviyā*) are अश्विया (*aśviyā*), the enemy's herds of horses; he conquered them completely. Likewise he conquered पूर्वीः (*pūrvīḥ*), the many enemy armies. The sense is that Indra, having conquered all enemies, carried off all their wealth in cattle and the rest. शाकैः (*śākaiḥ*) means by his powers; नृतमः (*nṛtamaḥ*) is the foremost leader, the one who in the highest degree brings about cattle and the rest. That Indra, praised by these leaders, the praisers, is विभक्ता (*vibhaktā*) of this रायः (*rāyaḥ*), the wealth in the form of cattle and the rest, that is, the maker of its division among the praisers: he is the giver. And further he is संभरः (*saṃbharaḥ*) of वस्वः (*vasvaḥ*), the wealth: its bearer and holder.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—which
- मघवा (*maghavā*)—wealthy
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- गाः (*gāḥ*)—the cows of the asuras
- सं अजयत् (*saṃ ajayat*)—conquered completely
- हिरण्या (*hiraṇyā*)—their wealth
- सं (*saṃ*) (अजयत् (*ajayat*))—seized completely
- अश्विया (*aśviyā*)—took all their horses completely (and)
- पूर्विः (*pūrviḥ*)—conquered their boundless armies; that Indra
- शाकैः (*śākaiḥ*)—endowed with powers
- नृतमः (*nṛtamaḥ*)—and being the leader
- एभिः नृभिः (*ebhiḥ nṛbhiḥ*)—(praised) by these human praisers
- अस्य रायः (*asya rāyaḥ*)—of this wealth
- विभक्ता (*vibhaktā*)—becomes the divider
- वस्वः (*vasvaḥ*)—of this same wealth
- संभरश्च (*saṃbharaśca*)—he becomes also the holder

Gist

The wealthy Indra who has completely conquered all the boundless enemy armies, carried off the cows and horses of the asuras, and completely seized all their wealth, that same Indra, endowed with powers and being the leader, praised by these human praisers, becomes the giver of that wealth to the sacrificers. And he becomes also the holder of the wealth.

English translation

Indra, the lord of opulence, who has overcome many (enemies) has completely won (their) cattle, (their) gold, (their) horses : chief leader by his energies, praised by these his worshippers, he is the distributor of riches, the bestower of wealth.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

किय॑त्स्वि॒दिन्द्रो॒ अध्ये॑ति मा॒तुः किय॑त्पि॒तुर्ज॑नि॒तुर्यो ज॒जान॑ ।
यो अ॑स्य॒ शुष्मं॑ मुहु॒कैरिय॑र्ति॒ वातो॒ न जू॒तः स्त॒नय॑द्भिर॒भ्रैः ॥ १२ ॥

> *kiyatsvidindro adhyeti mātuḥ kiyatpiturjanituryo jajāna |*
> *yo asya śuṣmaṃ muhukairiyarti vāto na jūtaḥ stanayadbhirabhraiḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कियत् । स्वित् । इंद्रः । अधि । एति । मातुः । कियत् । पितुः । जनितुः । यः । जजान।
> यः । अस्य । शुष्मं । मुहुकैः । इयर्ति । वातः । न । जूतः । स्तनयत्भिः ।
> अभ्रैः ॥ १२ ॥

> *kiyat | svit | iṃdraḥ | adhi | eti | mātuḥ | kiyat | pituḥ | janituḥ | yaḥ | jajāna|*
> *yaḥ | asya | śuṣmaṃ | muhukaiḥ | iyarti | vātaḥ | na | jūtaḥ | stanayatbhiḥ |*
> *abhraiḥ ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> य इंद्रो मातुर्जनन्याः सकाशात्कियत्स्विद्यावद्बलमध्येति । अधिगच्छति ।
> पितुः सकाशात्कियद्यावद्बलमधिगच्छति । य इंद्रो जनितुर्जयितुर्यस्मात्पजापतेः सकाशादिदं दृश्यमानं जगज्ञजान ! अजनयत् । य इंद्रस्तस्मात्पजापतेः
> सकाशादस्य जगतः शुष्मं यावद्बलं मुहुकैर्मुहुर्मुहुरियर्ति । प्रेरयति ।
> स्तनयद्भिर्गर्जद्भिरभ्रैर्मेघैर्जूतः प्रेरितो वातो न वायुरिव तथा स इंद्रः
> स्तोतृभिर्जूतः प्रेरितो हविष्पदानार्थमाहूतो भवति ॥

> *ya iṃdro māturjananyāḥ sakāśātkiyatsvidyāvadbalamadhyeti | adhigacchati |*
> *pituḥ sakāśātkiyadyāvadbalamadhigacchati | ya iṃdro*

> *janiturjayituryasmātpajāpateḥ sakāśādidaṃ dṛśyamānaṃ jagajjajāna !*
> *ajanayat | ya iṃdrastasmātpajāpateḥ*
> *sakāśādasya jagataḥ śuṣmaṃ yāvadbalaṃ muhukairmuhurmuhuriyarti*
> *| prerayati |*
> *stanayaddhirgarjaddirabhrairmeghairjūtaḥ prerito vāto na vāyuriva*
> *tathā sa iṃdraḥ*
> *stotṛbhirjūtaḥ prerito haviṣpadānārthamāhūto bhavati ||*

Summary

The Indra who derives from his mother, the one who bore him, कियत्स्वित् (*kiyatsvit*), as much strength as there is; and from his father he obtains as much strength as there is. The Indra from whom, as जनितुः (*janituḥ*), the begetter, namely Prajāpati, this visible world was born, that is, was produced: that Indra, from that Prajāpati, sets in motion again and again (मुहुकैः (*muhukaiḥ*)) शुष्मं (*śuṣmaṃ*), the strength, of this world. As the wind (वातो न (*vāto na*)) is driven by thundering (स्तनयद्भिः (*stanayadbhiḥ*)) clouds, so that Indra is impelled by the praisers and, being invoked, comes to bestow the oblation.

Word-to-word meaning

- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Indra
- जनितुः (*janituḥ*)—with the help of Prajāpati, the begetter of the world
- जजान (*jajāna*)—created this world
- यः (*yaḥ*)—which Indra
- स्तनयद्भिः (*stanayadbhiḥ*)—by thundering
- अभ्रैः (*abhraiḥ*)—clouds
- जूतः (*jūtaḥ*)—impelled
- वातो न (*vāto na*)—like the wind
- अस्य (*asya*)—of this world
- शुष्मं (*śuṣmaṃ*)—the strength
- मुहुकैः (*muhukaiḥ*)—again and again
- इयर्ति (*iyarti*)—sets in motion; (that) इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—that same Indra
- मातुः (*mātuḥ*)—from his mother
- कियत् स्वित् (*kiyat svit*)—some strength

- अध्येति (*adhyeti*)—obtains
- कियत् (*kiyat*)—some strength
- पितुः (*pituḥ*)—obtains from his father

Gist

The Indra who created this world with the help of Prajāpati, the begetter of the world, and who, like the wind driven by thundering clouds, sets in motion the strength of this world again and again, that same Indra obtains some strength from his mother. And he obtains some strength from his father also.

English translation

Some portion (of his strength) Indra derives from his mother, some-portion from his father : he who, through his progenitor, has begotten (the

world), and animates its vigour repeatedly, as the wind is driven by thundering clouds.

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

क्षि॒यन्तं॑ त्व॒मक्षिं॑यन्तं कृ॒णो॒तीयं॑र्ति रे॒णुं म॒घवा॑ स॒मो
हं॑म् ।
वि॒भ॒ञ्ज॒नु॒र॒शनिं॑माँ इ॒व द्यौरु॒त स्तो॒तारं॑ म॒घवा॒ वसौं॑
धात् ॥ १३ ॥

> *kṣiyantaṃ tvamakṣiyantaṃ kṛṇotīyarti reṇuṃ maghavā samoham |*
> *vibhañjanuraśanimā~ iva dyauruta stotāraṃ maghavā vasau dhāt ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> क्षियंतं । त्वं । अक्षियंतं । कृणोति । इयर्ति । रेणुं । मघवा । संओहं ।
> विभंजनुः । अशनिमान्इव । द्यौः । उत । स्तोतारं । मघवा । वसौ । धात् ॥

> *kṣiyaṃtaṃ | tvaṃ | akṣiyaṃtaṃ | kṛṇoti | iyarti | reṇuṃ | maghavā |*
> *saṃohaṃ |*
> *vibhaṃjanuḥ | aśanimāniva | dyauḥ | uta | stotāraṃ | maghavā |*
> *vasau | dhāt ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मघवा धनवानिंद्रः क्षियंतं धनराहित्येन क्षीयमाणं त्वमेकं जनमक्षियंतं धनेनाक्षीयमाणं कृणोति
> । करोति । अकिंचनः कश्चित्पुरुष इंद्रं स्तुत्वा
> धनसमृद्धोऽभवदित्यर्थः । अशनिमानशनिना युक्तो द्यौरिवांतरिक्षमिन विभंजनुः
> शत्रूणां विशेषेण भंजको मघवेंद्रः समोहं समूढं रेणुं पापमियर्ति !
> स्तोतुः सकाशात्पेरयति । उतापि च मघवा धनवानिंद्रः स्तोतारं वसौ धने
> धात् । अधात् । निदधाति ॥

> *maghavā dhanavāniṃdraḥ kṣiyaṃtaṃ dhanarāhityena kṣīyamāṇaṃ*
> *tvamekaṃ janamakṣiyaṃtaṃ dhanenākṣīyamāṇaṃ kṛṇoti | karoti |*
> *akiṃcanaḥ kaścitpuruṣa iṃdraṃ stutvā*
> *dhanasamṛddho 'bhavadityarthaḥ | aśanimānaśaninā yukto*
> *dyaurivāṃtarikṣamina vibhaṃjanuḥ*
> *śatrūṇāṃ viśeṣeṇa bhaṃjako maghaveṃdraḥ samohaṃ samūḍhaṃ*
> *reṇuṃ pāpamiyarti !*
> *stotuḥ sakāśātperayati | utāpi ca maghavā dhanavāniṃdraḥ stotāraṃ*
> *vasau dhane*
> *dhāt | adhāt | nidadhāti ‖*

Summary

Maghavan, the wealthy Indra, makes क्षियंतं (*kṣiyaṃtaṃ*), one who is declining through want of wealth, त्वं (*tvaṃ*), a single man, अक्षियंतं (*akṣiyaṃtaṃ*), one not declining but possessed of wealth. The sense is that some penniless man, having praised Indra, became rich in wealth. Like द्यौः (*dyauḥ*), the sky, furnished with the thunderbolt (अशनिमान् (*aśanimān*)), Indra Maghavan, विभंजनुः (*vibhaṃjanuḥ*), the special breaker of enemies, drives away रेणुं (*reṇuṃ*), the dust, that is, sin, समोहं (*samohaṃ*), that has been piled together: he sets it in motion away from the praiser. And further Maghavan, the wealthy Indra, places the praiser in वसौ (*vasau*), wealth: धात् (*dhāt*) is "has placed", he establishes.

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Word-to-word meaning

- मघवा (*maghavā*)—(O Indra) you who are wealthy
- त्वं (*tvaṃ*)—you
- क्षियंतं (*kṣiyaṃtaṃ*)—the man who is perishing through want of wealth
- अक्षियंतं (*akṣiyaṃtaṃ*)—so that, not perishing, he becomes prosperous
- कृणोति (*kṛṇoti*)—you make
- अशनिमान् (*aśanimān*)—furnished with lightning
- द्यौः (*dyauḥ*) (इव (*iva*))—like the sky
- विभंजनुः (*vibhaṃjanuḥ*)—the destroyer of enemies
- मघवा (*maghavā*)—Indra
- समोहं (*samohaṃ*)—that has been gathered together
- रेणुं (*reṇuṃ*)—sin
- इयर्ति (*iyarti*)—drives away
- उत (*uta*)—and
- मघवा (*maghavā*)—the wealthy Indra
- स्तोतारं (*stotāraṃ*)—the praiser
- वसौ (*vasau*)—in the midst of wealth
- धात् (*dhāt*)—places

Gist

O Indra, you who are wealthy make a man who is perishing for lack of wealth not perish but become well nourished. Indra, the destroyer of enemies, like the sky with its thunderbolt, drives away the sin that has been heaped up together; and Indra the wealthy sets the worshipper amid riches.

English translation

You are the Maghavan who makes one man destitute, another prosperous, who (scatters from his worshipper) the accumulated dust (of sin,) the destroyer (of foes), like the heaven with the thunderbolt, Maghavan conducts his worshipper to wealth

Ṛk 14

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं च॒क्रमि॑षण॒त्सूर्य॑स्य॒ न्येत॑शं रीरमत्ससृमा॒णम् ।
आ कृ॒ष्ण ई॑ जुहुरा॒णो जि॑घर्ति त्व॒चो बु॒ध्ने रज॑
सो अ॒स्य योनौ॑ ॥ १४ ॥

> *ayaṃ cakramiṣaṇatsūryasya nyetaśaṃ rīramatsasṛmāṇam |*
> *ā kṛṣṇa īṃ juhurāṇo jigharti tvaco budhne rajaso asya yonau ‖ 14 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । चक्रं । इषणत् । सूर्यस्य । नि । एतशं । रीरमत् । सस्यमाणं ।
> आ । कृष्णः । ईं । जुहुराणः । जिघर्ति । त्वचः । बुद्धे । रजसः । अस्य । योनौ ॥ १४ ॥

> *ayaṃ | cakraṃ | iṣaṇat | sūryasya | ni | etaśaṃ | rīramat | sasyamāṇaṃ |*
> *ā | kṛṣṇaḥ | īṃ | juhurāṇaḥ | jigharti | tvacaḥ | buddhe | rajasaḥ | asya | yonau ‖ 14 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> प्रैतशं सूर्ये पस्पृधानमित्यर्धर्चे । ऋग्वे. १–६१–१५ । पूर्वं काचिदाख्यायिका सूचिता । अत्राप्ययं चक्रमिति पूर्वार्धे सा सूच्यते । स्वश्वनामा
> कश्चिद्राजा । स च पुत्रार्थं सूर्यमुपास्ते । स च सूर्यः पुत्ररूपेण स्वयमेव
> तत्रोत्पन्नः सन् एतशाख्येन महर्षिणा सार्धं युद्धं चकार । तदानीं स यषिर्युद्दे जयार्थमिंद्रं तुष्टाव । स इंद्रस्तेन स्तूयमानः सन् स्वश्वपुत्रस
> ◌ूर्यस्य संबंधिनः संग्रामादेनमपालयदिति । अयमिंद्रः सूर्यस्य चित्रमायुधमिषणत् । प्रैरयत् ।
> ससृमाणु युद्धार्थं सरंतं गच्छंतमेतरना–

> *praitaśaṃ sūrye paspṛdhānamityardharcè | ṛgve. 1-61-15 | pūrvaṃ kācidākhyāyikā sūcitā | atrāpyayaṃ cakramiti pūrvārdhe sā sūcyate | svaśvanāmā*
> *kaścidrājā | sa ca putrārthaṃ sūryamupāste | sa ca sūryaḥ putrarūpeṇa svayameva*
> *tatrotpannaḥ san etaśākhyena maharṣiṇā sārdhaṃ yuddhaṃ cakāra | tadānīṃ sa yaṣiryudde jayārthamiṃdraṃ tuṣṭāva | sa iṃdrastena*

> *stūyamānaḥ san svaśvaputrasa*
> *ūryasya saṃbaṃdhinaḥ saṃgrāmādenamapālayaditi | ayamiṃdraḥ*
> *sūryasya citramāyudhamiṣaṇat | prairayat | sasṛmāṇu yuddhārthaṃ*
> *saraṃtaṃ gacchaṃtametaranā-*

> मानमृषिं नि रीरमत् । न्यरीरमत् । निवारितवान् । जुहुराणः कुटिलं यथा भवति
> तथा संचरन् कृष्णः कृष्णवर्णो मेघस्त्वचस्तेजसो बुद्धे मूलभूते रजसोऽस्योदकस्य योन्सौ
> स्थानेंतरिक्षे स्थितमीमेनमिंद्रमा जिघर्ति। आसिंचति । शत्रूणां
> प्रेरिताच्चक्रादेस्रस्तं ररक्षेत्यर्थः ॥

> *mānamṛṣiṃ ni rīramat | nyarīramat | nivāritavān | juhurāṇaḥ kuṭilaṃ yathā bhavati*
> *tathā saṃcaran kṛṣṇaḥ kṛṣṇavarṇo meghastvacastejaso buddhe*
> *mūlabhūte rajaso 'syodakasya yonsau sthāneṃtarikṣe*
> *sthitamīmenamiṃdramā jigharti| āsiṃcati | śatrūṇāṃ*
> *preritāccakrādesrastaṃ rarakṣetyarthaḥ ||*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says that in the half-verse प्रैतशं सूर्ये पस्पृधानं (*praitaśaṃ sūrye paspṛdhānaṃ*) (Ṛg. 1-61-15) a certain story was already hinted at, and that it is hinted at here too in the first half of the verse beginning अयं चक्रं (*ayaṃ cakraṃ*). A king named Svaśva worshipped Sūrya for the sake of a son. Sūrya himself was born there in the form of a son and fought a battle with the great sage named Etaśa. Then that sage praised Indra for victory in the battle. Indra, being praised by him, protected him from the battle with Sūrya, who was the son of Svaśva. Then the verse: this Indra hurled the wondrous weapon of Sūrya; he restrained the sage called Etaśa, who was going forth to the fight (the text continues on the next page).

Etaśa was held back, restrained. Moving in a crooked course, the dark-coloured cloud, standing in the sky, which is the root of radiance and the birthplace of this water, sprinkles Indra. The meaning is: he protected him from the discus and other weapons hurled by the enemies.

Word-to-word meaning

- अयं (*ayaṃ*)—this Indra

- सूर्यस्य (*sūryasya*)—of Sūrya
- चक्रं(*cakraṃ*)—the weapon called the discus
- इषणत् (*iṣaṇat*)—hurled
- सस्यमाणं (*sasyamāṇaṃ*)—who had set out for battle
- एतशं (*etaśaṃ*)—the sage named Etaśa
- नि रीरमत् (*ni rīramat*)—restrained
- जुहुराणः (*juhurāṇaḥ*)—moving crookedly
- कृष्णः (*kṛṣṇaḥ*)—the dark-coloured cloud
- त्वचः (*tvacaḥ*)—of radiance
- बुध्ने (*budhne*)—which is the root
- अस्य रजसः (*asya rajasaḥ*)—of this water
- योन्सौ (*yonsau*)—being in the sky, which is the place of origin
- ईं (*īṃ*)—upon Indra
- आ जिघर्ति (*ā jigharti*)—pours down rain and cools

Gist

Indra hurled the weapon of Sūrya called the discus, and restrained the sage Etaśa who had set out for battle. The dark, crookedly moving cloud, being in the sky, which is the root of radiance and the birthplace of water, pours rain upon Indra and cools him.

English translation

He has hurled the wheel (of the chariot) of the sun, and has stopped Etasa going forth to (battle): the dark undulating cloud bedews him, (stay- ing) at the root of radiance in the regions of its waters ;

Special Topics

The commentator indicates that there is an ancient story in the commentary on the Ṛk प्रैतशं सूर्ये पस्पृधानं (*praitaśaṃ sūrye paspṛdhānaṃ*) (Ṛ. Saṃ. 1-61-15) and explains it again here: स्वश्वनामा कश्चिद्राजा । स च पुत्रार्थं सूर्यमुपास्ते । स च सूर्यः पुत्ररूपेण स्वयमेव तत्रोत्पन्नः सन् एतशाख्येन महर्षिणा सार्धं युद्धं चकार । तदानीं स यषिर्युद्धे जयार्थमिंद्रं तुष्टाव । स इंद्रस्तेन स्तूयमानः सन् स्वश्वपुत्रस ूर्यस्य संबंधिनः संग्रामादेनमपालयदिति । (*svaśvanāmā kaścidrājā | sa ca putrārthaṃ sūryamupāste | sa ca sūryaḥ putrarūpeṇa svayameva tatrotpannaḥ san etaśākhyena maharṣiṇā sārdhaṃ yuddhaṃ cakāra |*

tadānīṃ sa yaṣiryudde jayārthamiṃdraṃ tuṣṭāva | sa iṃdrastena stūyamānaḥ san svaśvaputrasa ūryasya saṃbaṃdhinaḥ saṃgrāmādenamapālayaditi |) (Sā. Bhā.).

In ancient times there was a king named Svaśva. He worshipped Sūrya so that he might have a son. Then Sūrya himself was born to him as a son. While this son was fighting with a sage named Etaśa,

that sage Etaśa praised Indra so that he might win the battle. Then Indra, pleased with his praise, protected the sage Etaśa in the battle connected with Svaśva's son. This matter is indicated in this Ṛk.

Ṛk 15

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

असि॑क्न्यां॒ यज॑मानो॒ न होता॑ ॥ १५ ॥

> *asiknyāṃ yajamāno na hotā ‖ 15 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> असिक्नां । यजमानः । न । होता ॥ १५ ॥

> *asiknāṃ | yajamānaḥ | na | hotā ‖ 15 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> एकपदेयमृक् पूर्वर्चा सह दृष्टांतत्वेन संबद्यते । असिक्न्यां रात्रौ
> यजमानो न यजमान इव होता होतारमाह्वातारमुग्निं । द्वितीयार्थे
> प्रथमा । सोमेनासिंचति तद्वन्मेघ इंद्रमासिंचतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *ekapadeyamṛk pūrvarcā saha dṛṣṭāṃtatvena saṃbadyate | asiknyāṃ rātrau*
> *yajamāno na yajamāna iva hotā hotāramāhvātāramugniṃ | dvitīyārthe*
> *prathamā | somenāsiṃcati tadvanmegha iṃdramāsiṃcatītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

This one-word Ṛk is connected with the preceding verse as an illustration. असिक्न्यां (*asiknyāṃ*) means at night; यजमानो न (*yajamāno na*) means like a sacrificer; होता (*hotā*) is the Hotṛ, the caller, namely Agni; the nominative stands for the accusative. As the sacrificer sprinkles him with soma, so the cloud sprinkles Indra.

Word-to-word meaning

- असिक्नां (*asiknāṃ*)—at night
- यजमानो होता न (*yajamāno hotā na*)—as the sacrificer pours ghee and the like on the Hotṛ, Agni

Gist

As the sacrificer at night-times pours ghee and the like on the Hotṛ, Agni, and becomes the cause of Agni's satisfaction, so the cloud poured rain and became the cause of Indra's satisfaction.

English translation

As the sacrificer (pours the oblation) at night upon the fire.

Ṛk 16

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ग॒व्यन्त॒ इन्द्रं॑ स॒ख्याय॒ विप्रा॑ अश्वा॒यन्तो॒ वृष॑णं वा॒जय॑न्तः ।
ज॒नी॒यन्तो॑ जनि॒दामक्षि॑तोति॒मा च्या॑वयामोऽव॒ते न कोश॑म् ॥ १६ ॥

> *gavyanta indraṃ sakhyāya viprā aśvāyanto vṛṣaṇaṃ vājayantaḥ |*
> *janīyanto janidāmakṣitotimā cyāvayāmo 'vate na kośam ‖ 16 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> गव्यंतः । इंद्रं । सख्याय । विप्राः । अश्वयंतः । वृषणं । वाजयंतः ।
> जन्सियंतः । जन्सिदां । अक्षितऊतिं । आ । च्यवयामः। अवते । न । कोशं ॥ १६ ॥

> *gavyaṃtaḥ | iṃdraṃ | sakhyāya | viprāḥ | aśvayaṃtaḥ | vṛṣaṇaṃ | vājayaṃtaḥ |*
> *jansiyaṃtaḥ | jansidāṃ | akṣitaūtiṃ | ā | cyavayāmaḥ| avate | na | kośaṃ ‖ 16 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> गव्यंतो गा इच्छंतोऽश्वायंतोऽश्वानिच्छंतो वाजयंतो वाजमन्नमिच्छंतो जनीयंतो जायाश्चेच्छंतो विप्रा मेधाविनः स्तोतारो वयं
> सख्यायेंद्रसंबंधिने सखित्वाय वृषणं कामानां वर्षितारं जनिदां जाया.
> प्रदमक्षितोतिमक्षिणरक्षं । सर्वदा रक्षाकरमित्यर्थः । एवंभूतमिंद्रमा च्यावयामः । आगमयामः ।
> तत्र दृष्टांतः । अवते कूपे । अवत इति कूपनाम
> अवतोऽवटः क्रिविरिति कूपनामसु पाठात् । कोशं न जलोद्धरणपात्रमिव ।
> पुरुषा जलोद्धरणपात्रं जलेन पूरयितुं कूपे यथाच्यावयंर्ति तथा वयमाच्यावयाम इत्यथः 8

> *gavyaṃto gā icchaṃto 'śvāyaṃto 'śvānicchaṃto vājayaṃto vājamannamicchaṃto janīyaṃto jāyāścecchaṃto viprā medhāvinaḥ stotāro vayaṃ*
> *sakhyāyeṃdrasaṃbaṃdhine sakhitvāya vṛṣaṇaṃ kāmānāṃ varṣitāraṃ janidāṃ jāyā.*
> *pradamakṣitotimakṣiṇarakṣaṃ | sarvadā rakṣākaramityarthaḥ | evaṃbhūtamiṃdramā cyāvayāmaḥ | āgamayāmaḥ | tatra dṛṣṭāṃtaḥ |*
> *avate kūpe | avata iti kūpanāma*
> *avato 'vaṭaḥ kriviriti kūpanāmasu pāṭhāt | kośaṃ na jaloddharaṇapātramiva |*
> *puruṣā jaloddharaṇapātraṃ jalena pūrayituṃ kūpe yathācyāvayaṃti tathā vayamācyāvayāma ityarthaḥ 8*

Summary

We, the wise praisers, desiring cattle, horses, food and wives, for friendship with Indra, bring to us Indra, the showerer of desires, the giver of wives, whose protection is unfailing, that is, always protecting. The illustration: as into a well, like a vessel for drawing water. As men lower a water-drawing vessel into a well to fill it with

water, so we bring him. He cites the Nighaṇṭu reading of *avato avaṭaḥ kriviḥ* among the names of a well, to show that अवत (*avata*) is a name for a well.

Word-to-word meaning

- गव्यंतः (*gavyaṃtaḥ*)—those who wish for cows
- अश्वायंतः (*aśvāyaṃtaḥ*)—those who wish for horses
- वाजयंतः (*vājayaṃtaḥ*)—those who need food
- जनीयंतः (*janīyaṃtaḥ*)—those eager to obtain wives
- विप्राः (*viprāḥ*)—we, the wise (praisers)
- सख्याय (*sakhyāya*)—to win friendship
- वृषणं (*vṛṣaṇaṃ*)—showerer of desires
- जनिदां (*janidāṃ*)—giver of wives
- अक्षितोतिं (*akṣitotiṃ*)—giver of everlasting protection
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- अवते (*avate*)—into a well
- कोशं न (*kośaṃ na*)—as one lowers a water vessel
- आ च्यावयामः (*ā cyāvayāmaḥ*)—we urge him to come down to us

Gist

We (the praisers), wise, wishing for cattle, horses, food and wives, to win friendship with Indra, urge Indra, the showerer of desires, the giver of wives, the giver of everlasting protection, to come down to us, as a water vessel is lowered into a well.

English translation

May we (who are) wishing for cattle, for horses, for food, for wives, through his friendship induce Indra, the showerer (of benefits) the giver of wives, the unwearied granter (of protection) to come down, as a bucket (is lowered) into a well.

Ṛk 17

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

त्रा॒ता नो॑ बोधि॒ ददृ॑शान आ॒पिर॑भिख्या॒ता म॑र्डि॒ता सो॒म्याना॑म् ।
सखा॑ पि॒ता पि॒तृत॑मः पितॄ॒णां कर्ते॑मु लो॒कमु॑श॒ते व॑यो॒धाः ॥ १७ ॥

> *trātā no bodhi dadṛśāna āpirabhikhyātā marḍitā somyānām |*
> *sakhā pitā pitṛtamaḥ pitṝṇāṃ kartemu lokamuśate vayodhāḥ ‖ 17 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> त्राता । नः । बोधि । ददृशानः । आपिः । अभिख्याता । मर्डिता । सोम्यानां ।
> सखा । पिता । पितृतमः । पित्थणां । कर्ता । ईं । ऊं इति । लोकं । उशते ।
> वयोऽधाः ॥ १७ ॥

> *trātā | naḥ | bodhi | dadṛśānaḥ | āpiḥ | abhikhyātā | marḍitā |*
> *somyānāṃ |*
> *sakhā | pitā | pitṛtamaḥ | pitthaṇāṃ | kartā | īṃ | ūṃ iti | lokaṃ |*
> *uśate |*
> *vayo 'dhāḥ ‖ 17 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र आपिराप्तो ददृशानः सर्वं पालकत्वेन पश्यंत्वं नोऽस्माकं त्राता
> रक्षको बोधि । भव । किंच । अभिख्याताभिद्रष्टा मर्डिता सुखयिता सोम्यानां
> सोमार्हाणां यजमानादीनां सखा प्रजापतिना समानख्यातिः पिता पालकः ।
> केवलं पालको न किंतु पित्यणां पालकानां मध्ये पितृतमोऽतिशयेन पालकः
> कर्तेमु पित्यणां स्रष्टा च त्वं लोकं स्वर्गादिलोकमुशते कामयमानाय
> स्तोत्रे वयोधाः । वय इत्यन्ननामैतत् । अन्नप्रदो भव ॥

> *he iṃdra āpirāpto dadṛśānaḥ sarvaṃ pālakatvena paśyaṃtvaṃ no*
> *'smākaṃ trātā*
> *rakṣako bodhi | bhava | kiṃca | abhikhyātābhidraṣṭā marḍitā sukhayitā*
> *somyānāṃ*

> *somārhāṇāṃ yajamānādīnāṃ sakhā prajāpatinā samānakhyātiḥ pitā pālakaḥ |*
> *kevalaṃ pālako na kiṃtu pityaṇāṃ pālakānāṃ madhyè pitṛtamo 'tiśayena pālakaḥ*
> *kartemu pityaṇāṃ sraṣṭā ca tvaṃ lokaṃ svargādilokamuśate kāmayamānāya*
> *stotre vayodhāḥ | vaya ityannanāmaitat | annaprado bhava ||*

Summary

O Indra, you who are a kinsman and see all as protector, be our saviour. Further: be the overseer and giver of happiness to those fit for soma, the sacrificers and others; a friend, of fame equal to Prajāpati; a protector. Not merely a protector: among protectors the supreme protector, and the maker of the protectors; to the praiser desiring the world, heaven and the rest, be the वयोधाः (*vayodhāḥ*). वयः (*vayaḥ*) is a name for food; be the giver of food.

Word-to-word meaning

- (O Indra) आपिः (*āpiḥ*)—kinsman to us
- ददृशानः (*dadṛśānaḥ*)—you who look kindly upon all
- नः (*naḥ*)—to us
- तात्रा (*tātrā*)—that you should be the protector
- भोधि (*bhodhi*)—know (be the protector)
- अभिख्याता (*abhikhyātā*)—one who looks after all of us like a supervisor
- मर्डिता (*marḍitā*)—giver of happiness
- सोम्यानां (*somyānāṃ*)—to the sacrificers worthy to offer soma
- सखा (*sakhā*)—friend
- पिता (*pitā*)—protector
- पित्थणां (*pitthaṇāṃ*)—among protectors
- पितृतमः (*pitṛtamaḥ*)—the best protector
- कर्ता ईं उ (*kartā īṃ u*)—you, the creator of all
- लोकं (*lokaṃ*)—the world, heaven and the rest
- उशते (*uśate*)—to the praiser who desires
- वयोधाः (*vayodhāḥ*)—be the giver of food

Gist

O Indra, you who are our kinsman and look kindly on all, be our protector. You who look after all of us like a supervisor, give happiness, are a friend to the sacrificers worthy of offering soma, a protector, the best protector among all protectors, and the creator of all, be the giver of food to the praiser who desires heaven and the other worlds.

English translation

Be our preserver, you who are looking (benevolently upon) all ; a kinsman (to us); a supervisor (of all things), a bestower of felicity on those who are worthy (to offer) libations ; a friend, a protector, a defender in the highest degree among defenders, a creater : (be you, who bestow) the world of heaven upon him who desires it, the giver to us of food.

Ṛk 18

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स॒खी॒य॒ताम॑वि॒ता बो॑धि॒ सखा॑ गृणा॒न इ॑न्द्र स्तुव॒ते वयो॑ धाः ।
व॒यं ह्या ते॑ चकृ॒मा स॒बाध॑ आ॒भिः शमी॑भिर्म॒हय॑न्त इन्द्र ॥ १८ ॥

> *sakhīyatāmavitā bodhi sakhā gṛṇāna indra stuvate vayo dhāḥ |*
> *vayaṃ hyā te cakṛmā sabādha ābhiḥ śamībhirmahayanta indra ‖ 18 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सखियतां । अविता । बोधि । सखा । गृणानः । इंद्र । स्तुवते । वयः । धाः ।
> वयं । हि । आ । ते । चकृम । सबाधः । अभिः । शमीभिः । महयंतः । इंद्र॥ १८ ॥

> *sakhiyatāṃ | avitā | bodhi | sakhā | gṛṇānaḥ | iṃdra | stuvate | vayaḥ | dhāḥ |*
> *vayaṃ | hi | ā | te | cakṛma | sabādhaḥ | abhiḥ | śamībhiḥ | mahayaṃtaḥ | iṃdra‖ 18 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र त्वं सखीयतां सखित्वमिच्छतामस्माकमविता रक्षिता बोधि। भव। तथा
> गृणानः 8 स्तूयमानस्त्वं सखा भव । हे इंद्र स्तुवते स्तुतिं कुर्वते मह्यं
> वयोऽन्नं धाः । अधाः । धेहि । हे इंद्र सबाधो बाधासहिता वयं हि वयं

> *he iṃdra tvaṃ sakhīyatāṃ sakhitvamicchatāmasmākamavitā rakṣitā bodhi| bhava| tathā*
> *gṛṇānaḥ 8 stūyamānastvaṃ sakhā bhava | he iṃdra stuvate stutiṃ kurvate mahyaṃ*
> *vayo 'nnaṃ dhāḥ | adhāḥ | dhehi | he iṃdra sabādho bādhāsahitā vayaṃ hi vayaṃ*

> खलु ते त्वामा चक्रम । आह्वयामः । किं कुर्वंतः । अभिः प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानैः शमीभिः स्तुतिरूपैः कर्मभिर्महयंतस्त्वां पूजयंतः ॥

> *khalu te tvāmā cakrama | āhvayāmaḥ | kiṃ kurvaṃtaḥ | abhiḥ pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamānaiḥ śamībhiḥ stutirūpaiḥ karmabhirmahayaṃtastvāṃ pūjayaṃtaḥ ‖*

Summary

O Indra, be the protector of us who desire friendship. Being praised, be our friend. O Indra, to me who praise you, give food. O Indra, we, together with our troubles, ... (the block breaks off here in this window).

The sentence continues from the previous page. "We (खलु (*khalu*)) call you (आ चक्रम (*ā cakrama*), "we invoke"), worshipping you with these visibly present holy rites (शमीभिः (*śamībhiḥ*)) that take the form of praise."

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सखीयतां (*sakhīyatāṃ*)—to us who desire your friendship

- अविता (*avitā*)—as a protector
- बोधि (*bodhi*)—know (regard yourself)
- गृणानः (*gṛṇānaḥ*)—you who are praised
- सखा (*sakhā*)—become our friend
- स्तुवते (*stuvate*)—to me who praise you
- वयः (*vayaḥ*)—food
- धाः (*dhāḥ*)—give
- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- सबाधः (*sabādhaḥ*)—as those who suffer affliction
- वयं (*vayaṃ*)—we
- आभिः शमीभिः (*ābhiḥ śamībhiḥ*)—with these rites in the form of praise
- महयंतः (*mahayaṃtaḥ*)—worshipping you
- ते (*te*)—you
- आ चक्रम (*ā cakrama*)—we pray and call

Gist

O Indra, know that you must be the protector of us who desire your friendship. You, who deserve to be praised, be our friend. Give food to me who praise you. O Indra, we, enduring the affliction of austerity, worship you with these rites in the form of praise, and we pray to you and call you.

English translation

Regard yourself as a protector of those who desire your friendship ; be a friend deserving of commendation : grant, Indra, food to him who praises (you) : suffering difficulties, we make our supplications to you, worshipping you with these holy rites.

Special Topics

The Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra (Ā. 3-8) explains that in the sacrifice addressed to Indra Vṛtrahan, when the oblation of the puroḍāśa is made, this Ṛk beginning स्तुत इंद्रः (*stuta iṃdraḥ*) is to be used as the yājyā mantra, by the sūtra सुत इंद्रो मघवा यद्ध वृत्रैवा वस्व इंद्रः सत्यः सम्राट् (*suta iṃdro maghavā yaddha vṛtraivā vasva iṃdraḥ satyaḥ samrāṭ*).

Ṛk 19

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

स्तु॒त इन्द्रो॑ म॒घवा॒ यद्ध॑ वृ॒त्रा भूरी॒ण्येको॑ अप्र॒ती नि॑ हन्ति ।
अ॒स्य प्रि॒यो जं॑रि॒ता यस्य॒ शर्म॒न्नकिं॑र्दे॒वा वा॒रयं॑न्ते॒ न मर्ता॑ः ॥ १९ ॥

> *stuta indro maghavā yaddha vṛtrā bhūrīṇyeko apratīni hanti |*
> *asya priyo jaritā yasya śarmannakirdevā vārayante na martāḥ ‖ 19 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> स्तुतः । इंद्रः । मघवा । यत् । ह । वृत्रा । भूरीणि । एकः । अप्रतीनि । हंति ।
> अस्य । प्रियः । जरिता । यस्य । शर्मन् । नकिः । देवाः । वारयंते । न । मर्ताः ॥

> *stutaḥ | iṃdraḥ | maghavā | yat | ha | vṛtrā | bhūrīṇi | ekaḥ | apratīni | haṃti |*
> *asya | priyaḥ | jaritā | yasya | śarman | nakiḥ | devāḥ | vārayaṃte | na | martāḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंद्रस्य वृत्रघ्नः पुरोडाशस्य स्तुत इंद्र इति याज्या । सूत्रितं च । स्तुत
> इंद्रो मघवा यद्ध वृत्रैना वस्व इंद्रः सत्यः सम्राट् । आ. ३-८ । इति ॥
> यद्ध यदा खलु मघवा धनवानिंद्रः स्तुतोऽस्माभिः स्तुतो भवति तदेंद्र
> एकोऽसहाय एव भूरीणि बहून्यप्रतीन्यप्रतिगमनानि । अभिगमनयुक्तानीत्यर्थः ।
> वृत्रा वृत्राणि शत्रून्हंति । हिनस्ति । यस्येंद्रस्य शर्मन् शर्मण्याश्रये वर्तमानं
> स्तोतारं देवा नकिर्वारयंते । निवारणं न कुर्वंति । मर्ताश्च न निवारयंते
> अस्येंद्रस्य जरिता स्तोता प्रियो भवति ॥

> *iṃdrasya vṛtraghnaḥ puroḍāśasya stuta iṃdra iti yājyā | sūtritaṃ ca | stuta*
> *iṃdro maghavā yaddha vṛtrainā vasva iṃdraḥ satyaḥ samrāṭ | ā. 3-8 | iti ‖*
> *yaddha yadā khalu maghavā dhanavāniṃdraḥ stuto 'smābhiḥ stuto*

> *bhavati tadeṃdra*
> *eko 'sahāya eva bhūrīṇi bahūnyapratīnyapratigamanāni |*
> *abhigamanayuktānītyarthaḥ |*
> *vṛtrā vṛtrāṇi śatrunhaṃti | hinasti | yasyeṃdrasya śarman*
> *śarmaṇyāśraye vartamānaṃ*
> *stotāraṃ devā nakirvārayaṃte | nivāraṇaṃ na kurvaṃti | martāśca na nivārayaṃte*
> *asyeṃdrasya jaritā stotā priyo bhavati ‖*

Summary

स्तुत इंद्रः (*stuta iṃdraḥ*) is the yājyā for the puroḍāśa of Indra Vṛtrahan, and it is prescribed in the sūtra (Ā. 3-8). When Indra, the possessor of wealth (मघवा (*maghavā*)), is praised by us, then he alone, without helper, slays many (भूरीणि (*bhūrīṇi*)) foes (वृत्रा (*vṛtrā*)) who are अप्रतीनि (*apratīni*), that is, "not to be approached" or "not yielding". The worshipper who dwells in the shelter (शर्मन् (*śarman*)) of this Indra is not obstructed by gods or by mortals. The praiser of this Indra is dear to him.

Word-to-word meaning

युद्ध (*yuddha*)	when
मघवा (*maghavā*)	the wealthy
इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)	Indra
स्तुतः (*stutaḥ*)	is praised (then)
एकः (*ekaḥ*)	he alone
भूरीणि (*bhūrīṇi*)	numerous
अप्रतीनि (*apratīni*)	and not yielding to others
वृत्रा (*vṛtrā*)	all enemies
हंति (*haṃti*)	destroys
यस्य (*yasya*)	of that Indra
शर्मन् (*śarman*)	the praiser who is in his protection
देवाः (*devāḥ*)	the gods
नकिः वारयंते (*nakiḥ vārayaṃte*)	cannot oppose
मर्ताः (*martāḥ*)	mortals also
न (वारयंते) (*na (vārayaṃte)*)	cannot oppose
अस्य (*asya*)	to this Indra

- जरिता (*jaritā*)—the praiser
- प्रियः (*priyaḥ*)—becomes dear

Gist

As soon as Indra, the possessor of wealth, is praised, he, without the help of others, alone destroys all the numerous enemies who yield to none. Neither gods nor humans can oppose the praiser who is under Indra's protection. The praiser becomes dear to this Indra.

English translation

When Indra, the posssessor of opulence, is glorified, he singly destroys many unyielding foes: the worshipper is dear to him (who relies) on his protection, and neither gods nor men molest him

Ṛk 20

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒वा न॒ इन्द्रो॑ म॒घवा॑ विर॒प्शी करं॑त्स॒त्या चं॑र्षणी॒धृदं॑
न॒र्वा ।
त्वं राजा॑ ज॒नुषां॑ धेह्य॒स्मे अधि॒ श्रवो॒ माहिं॑नं॒ यज्ञं॑
रि॒त्रे ॥ २० ॥

> *evā na indro maghavā virapśī karatsatyā carṣaṇīdhṛdanarvā |*
> *tvaṃ rājā januṣāṃ dhehyasme adhi śravo māhinaṃ yajjaritre ‖ 20 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एव । नः । इंद्रः । मघवा । विरप्सी । करत् । सत्या । चर्षणीधृत् । अनर्वा ।
> त्वं । राजा । जनुषां । धेहि । अस्मे इति । अधि । श्रवः । माहिनं । यत् । जरित्रे ॥२०॥

> *eva* | *naḥ* | *iṃdraḥ* | *maghavā* | *virapsī* | *karat* | *satyā* | *carṣaṇīdhṛt* | *anarvā* |
> *tvaṃ* | *rājā* | *januṣāṃ* | *dhehi* | *asme iti* | *adhi* | *śravaḥ* | *māhinaṃ* | *yat* | *jaritre* ‖*20*‖

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अग्निमारुतशस्त्र एवा न इंद्र इति परिधानीया । सूत्रितं च । एवा न इंद्रो
> मघवा विरप्यीति परिदध्यात् । आ. ५–२० । इति ॥
> विरष्यी बहुविधशब्दवान् चर्षणीधृत् सर्वासां प्रजानां धारयितानर्वाप्रत्यृतः । केनापि
> प्रतिकूलेन न प्राप्त इत्यर्थः । मघवा धनवानिंद्र एवैवमस्माभिः
> स्तुतः सन् नोऽस्माकं सत्या सत्यरूपाण्यभिमतानि फलानि करत् । करोतु । हे इंद्र
> जनुषां जन्मवतां सर्वेषां राजा प्रभुत्वं माहिनं महिन्नोपेतं यच्छ्रवो
> यद्यशो जरित्रे स्तोत्रे देयं तद्यशोऽस्मे अस्मास्वधि अधिकत्वेन धेहि ॥ एवा न
> इंद्रो मघवा विरष्यीत्युत्तमया परिदधातीयं वा इंद्रो मघवा विरष्यीत्यादि
> ब्राह्मणं । ऐ. ब्रा. ३–३८ ॥

> *agnimārutaśastra evā na iṃdra iti paridhānīyā | sūtritaṃ ca | evā na*
> *iṃdro*
> *maghavā virapyīti paridadhyāt | ā. 5-20 | iti ||*
> *viraṣyī bahuvidhaśabdavān carṣaṇīdhṛt sarvāsāṃ prajānāṃ*
> *dhārayitānarvāpratyṛtaḥ | kenāpi pratikūlena na prāpta ityarthaḥ |*
> *maghavā dhanavānimdra evaivamasmābhiḥ*
> *stutaḥ san no 'smākaṃ satyā satyarūpāṇyabhimatāni phalāni karat |*
> *karotu | he iṃdra*
> *januṣāṃ janmavatāṃ sarvèṣāṃ rājā prabhutvaṃ māhinaṃ*
> *mahinnopetaṃ yacchravo*
> *yadyaśo jaritre stotre deyaṃ tadyaśo 'sme asmāsvadhi adhikatvena dhehi*
> *|| evā na*
> *iṃdro maghavā viraṣyītyuttamayā paridadhātīyaṃ vā iṃdro maghavā*
> *viraṣyītyādi*
> *brāhmaṇaṃ | ai. brā. 3-38 ||*

Summary

In the Agnimāruta-śastra, एवा न इंद्रः (*evā na iṃdraḥ*) is the concluding verse (paridhānīyā). It is prescribed: एवा न इंद्रो मघवा विरप्यीति परिदध्यात् (*evā na iṃdro maghavā virapyīti paridadhyāt*) (Ā. 5-20). Indra is विरष्यी (*viraṣyī*), "of many kinds of sound"; चर्षणीधृत् (*carṣaṇīdhṛt*), the upholder of all peoples; अनर्वा (*anarvā*), "not met" by any hostile force. Thus praised by us, may Indra, the wealthy, bring about for us true (सत्या (*satyā*)), real desired fruits. O Indra, lord of all born beings, place upon us in abundance the great glory which is to be given to the praiser. The Brāhmaṇa says: एवा न इंद्रो मघवा विरष्यीत्युत्तमया परिदधातीयं वा

इंद्रो मघवा विरष्यीत्यादि ब्राह्मणं (*evā na iṃdro maghavā viraṣyītyuttamayā paridadhātīyaṃ vā iṃdro maghavā viraṣyītyādi brāhmaṇaṃ*) (Ai. Brā. 3-38).

Word-to-word meaning

विरष्यी (*viraṣyī*)	of many kinds of sound
चर्षणीधृत् (*carṣaṇīdhṛt*)	who upholds all peoples
अनर्वा (*anarvā*)	unobstructed
मघवा (*maghavā*)	wealthy
इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)	Indra
एना (*enā*)	thus praised by us
नः (*naḥ*)	for us
सत्या (*satyā*)	true fruits
करत् (*karat*)	may he bring about
जनुषां (*januṣāṃ*)	of all beings that are born
राजा (*rājā*)	the lord
त्वं (*tvaṃ*)	you
माहिनं (*māhinaṃ*)	endowed with greatness
यत् श्रवः (*yat śravaḥ*)	the fame that is
जरित्रे (*jaritrè*)	to us who are praisers
अस्मे (*asme*)	in us
अधि धेहि (*adhi dhehi*)	cause to exist in abundance

Gist

May Indra, who is of many kinds of sound, upholds all peoples, is unobstructed and wealthy, being praised by us in many ways, bring about true fruits for us. O Indra, you who are lord of all beings that take birth, cause the fame endowed with greatness to be abundant in us, your praisers.

English translation

The many-voiced Indra, the possessor of opulence, the supporter of men, the irresistible, bestows upon us, when praised by us, assured (rewards): you, (Indra), are the king of men : grant to us abundantly that great fame which (is due) to (your) worshipper.

Special Topics

The Āśvalāyana Śrauta Sūtra (Ā. 5-20) prescribes that in reciting the mantras of the Agnimāruta-śastra this Ṛk एवा न इंद्रः (*evā na iṃdraḥ*) be recited as the concluding mantra, by the sūtra एवा न इंद्रो मघवा विरप्यीति परिदध्यात् (*evā na iṃdro maghavā virapyīti paridadhyāt*).

The Aitareya Brāhmaṇa also says that this Ṛk is to be recited as the concluding mantra of the Agnimāruta-śastra mantras (Ai. Brā. 13-38)[?462]. What is there is explained here: एवा न इंद्रो मघवा विरप्सीत्युत्तमया परिदधातीयं ना इंद्रो मघवा विरप्सी करत्सत्या चर्षणीधृदनर्वेतीयं वै सत्या चर्षणीधृदनर्वा (*evā na iṃdro maghavā virapsītyuttamayā paridadhātīyaṃ nā iṃdro maghavā virapsī karatsatyā carṣaṇīdhṛdanarvetīyaṃ vai satyā carṣaṇīdhṛdanarvā*) (Ai. Brā. 13-38).

This Indra is possessed of wealth, and is always engaged in activity. [The word विरप्ति (*virapti*) is derived from the root रभ राभस्ये (*rabha rābhasye*) and suggests one who, not being idle, is always engaged in some work.] With this Ṛk, which conveys these meanings on Indra's behalf, these Agnimāruta-śastra mantras are to be concluded. The words in this Ṛk, Indra and the rest,

also convey a sense referring to the Earth. The word चर्षणी (*carṣaṇī*) means human beings. Because he upholds or nourishes human beings, Indra is called चर्षणीधृत् (*carṣaṇīdhṛt*). The intention expressed here is: may such an Indra, descending from his mount the horse, come and sit on this our sacrificial ground, and, protecting the true sacrificial work from obstacles and the like, make it fruitful. It is said here that by touching the earth while reciting this mantra, the Earth is, as it were, prayed to.

त्वं राजा जनुषां धेह्यस्मे इतीयं वै राजा जनुषां अधि श्रवो माहिनं यज्जरित्र इतीयं वै माहिनं यज्ञश्रवो यजमानो जरिता यजमानाय्यैवैतामाशिषमाशास्ते॥ (*tvaṃ rājā januṣāṃ dhehyasme itīyaṃ vai rājā januṣāṃ adhi śravo māhinaṃ yajjaritra itīyaṃ vai māhinaṃ yajñaśravo yajamāno jaritā yajamānāyyaivaitāmāśiṣamāśāste*‖) (Ai. Brā. 13-38)

O Indra (or O Earth), you are king of all of us who are born, that is, of all, beginning with the officiating priests and the sacrificer; and you provide all our desires. Procure great fame and food for the sacrificer who is praising. In this sacrifice the sacrificer praises you much. For such a sacrificer, make the sacrifice he is performing fruitful and bestow great fame: thus the priests pray. This is the main purport.

Ṛk 21

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नू ष्टु॒त इ॑न्द्र॒ नू गृ॑णा॒न इषं॑ जरि॒त्रे न॒द्यो॒३॑ न पी॑पेः ।
अका॑रि ते हरिवो॒ ब्रह्म॒ नव्यं॑ धि॒या स्या॑म र॒थ्यः॑ सदा॒साः ॥ २१ ॥

> *nū ṣṭuta indra nū gṛṇāna iṣaṃ jaritre nadyo na pīpeḥ |*
> *akāri te harivo brahma navyaṃ dhiyā syāma rathyaḥ sadāsāḥ ‖ 21 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> नु । स्तुतः । इंद्र । नु । गृणानः । इषं । जरित्रे । नद्यः । न । पीपेरिति पीपेः ।
> अकारि । ते । हरिऽवः । ब्रह्म । नव्यं । धिया । स्याम । रथ्यः । सदाऽसाः ॥ २१ ॥

> *nu | stutaḥ | iṃdra | nu | gṛṇānaḥ | iṣaṃ | jaritre | nadyaḥ | na | pīperiti pīpeḥ |*
> *akāri | te | hari 'vaḥ | brahma | navyaṃ | dhiyā | syāma | rathyaḥ | sadā 'sāḥ ‖ 21 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र नु क्षिप्रं स्तुतः पूर्वैर्ऋषिभिः संस्तुतो नुक्षिप्रंगृणानोऽस्माभिः
> स्तूयमानश्च त्वमिषमन्नं जरित्रे स्तोत्रे मह्यं नद्यो न अद्भिन्नदीरिव सीपेः ।

> *he iṃdra nu kṣipraṃ stutaḥ pūrvairṛṣibhiḥ saṃstuto nukṣipraṃgṛṇāno 'smābhiḥ*
> *stūyamānaśca tvamiṣamannaṃ jaritre stotre mahyaṃ nadyo na adbhinnadīriva sīpeḥ |*

> प्यायय । प्रवृद्धं कुरु । हे इंद्र हरिवो हरिवन् हरिसंज्ञकाश्वोपेतेंद्र
> ते तुभ्यं नव्यं नवतरं ब्रह्म स्तोत्रमकारि । अस्माभिः क्रियते । रथ्यो रथवंतो
> वयं धिया प्रज्ञारूपया स्तुत्या सदासास्त्वां सर्वदा भजमानास्त्वदर्थं हवीरूपस्यान्नस्य दातारो
> ना स्याम । भूयास्मै ॥

> *pyāyaya | pravṛddhaṃ kuru | he iṃdra harivo harivan harisaṃjñakāśvopeteṃdra*
> *te tubhyaṃ navyaṃ navataraṃ brahma stotramakāri | asmābhiḥ kriyate | rathyo rathavaṃto*
> *vayaṃ dhiyā prajñārūpayā stutyā sadāsāstvāṃ sarvadā bhajamānāstvadarthaṃ havīrūpasyānnasya dātāro nā syāma | bhūyāsmai ||*

Summary

O Indra, you were quickly (नु (*nu*)) praised by the earlier seers and are now praised by us. Fill (पीपेः (*pīpeḥ*), "make swell") food for me, the praiser, as rivers are filled with water.

Make it abound. O Indra, lord of the horses called Hari, a newer hymn (*navyaṃ brahma*) has been made for you by us. We, possessed of chariots, with praise in the form of insight (धिया (*dhiyā*)), ever serving you (सदासाः (*sadāsāḥ*)), may become givers of oblation-food for you.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्र (*iṃdra*)—O Indra
- नु (*nu*)—quickly (in eagerness to worship you)
- स्तुतः (*stutaḥ*)—you who were praised by the seers of former times
- नु (*nu*)—with the same eager faith
- गृणानः (*gṛṇānaḥ*)—and praised by us
- जरित्रे (*jaritre*)—to me, the praiser
- नद्यो न (*nadyo na*)—as rivers are filled by their flood
- इषं (*iṣaṃ*)—food
- पीपेः (*pīpeḥ*)—fill up
- हरिवः (*harivaḥ*)—O Indra, who have horses called Hari
- ते (*te*)—addressed to you

- नव्यं (*navyaṃ*)—new
- ब्रह्म (*brahma*)—hymn
- अकारि (*akāri*)—is made by us
- रथ्यः (*rathyaḥ*)—we who have a chariot
- धिया (*dhiyā*)—with our praise in the form of insight
- सदासाः (*sadāsāḥ*)—offering oblations and the like to you
- स्याम (*syāma*)—grant that we may be

Gist

O Indra, you who were praised by the seers of former times eager to worship you alone, and are praised by us too with the same eager faith, fill up food for me, the praiser, as rivers are filled by their flood. O Indra, possessor of the horses called Hari, we make a new hymn addressed to you. Grant that we, possessors of an excellent chariot, may be, with our praise in the form of insight, offerers of oblations and the like to you.

English translation

Glorified (in the past), glorified, Indra, at present, satisfy your worshipper with food, as rivers (are filled with water): Lord of horses, a new hymn has been made for you : may we, possessed of chariots, be ever diligent in (your) praise.

Sūkta 18 (Maṇḍala 4)

Sāyaṇa's introduction to the sūkta

> अयं पंथा इति त्रयोदशर्चमष्टमं सूक्तं त्रैष्टुभं । अत्रानुक्रमणिका।
> अयं पंथाः सप्तोना संवाद इंद्रादितिनामदेवानामिति । यस्य वाक्यं स ऋषि–

> *ayaṃ paṃthā iti trayodaśarcamaṣṭamaṃ sūktaṃ traiṣṭubhaṃ | atrānukramaṇikā|*
> *ayaṃ paṃthāḥ saptonā saṃvāda iṃdrāditināmadevānāmiti | yasya vākyaṃ sa ṛṣi-*

Gist of the bhāṣya

The hymn अयं पंथा (*ayaṃ paṃthā*) has thirteen Ṛks and is the eighth sūkta, in the Triṣṭubh metre. The Anukramaṇikā says here: अयं पंथाः सप्तोना संवाद इंद्रादितिनामदेवानामिति (*ayaṃ paṃthāḥ saptonā saṃvāda iṃdrāditināmadevānāmiti*), and goes on to say that the seer is the one whose speech it is.[?463]

> र्या तेनोच्यते सा देवतेति परिभाषितत्वादृषिदेवते तत्र तत्र ज्ञातव्ये । अस्मिन्
> सूक्ते इंद्रादितिवामदेवसंवादरूपिणी काचिदाख्यायिका श्लोकरूपेण सूच्यते।
> गर्भस्थो ज्ञानसंपन्नो वामदेवो महामुनिः । मतिं चक्रे न जायेय योनिदेशात्तु मातृतः । किंतु
> पार्श्वादितश्चेति ज्ञात्वा नु जननी त्विदं । दध्यौ शांतै
> शचीं देवीमदितिं त्विंद्रमातरं ॥ अदितिस्त्विंद्रसहिता गर्भिणीमभ्यगाद्वने ।
> अदितींद्रवामदेवाः संवादमथ चक्रिरे॥ संवाद इति सूत्रेण कथा सैषात्र सूच्यते।
> नोक्तो वक्तृविशेषोऽत्र ह्युपदेशेश्वन्नुक्तितः ॥ अर्थतस्ववगंतव्यो वक्तृभेद
> इति स्थितिः । इंद्रोदितिर्यषिश्चास्मिन्मिथः सूक्ते समूचिरे ॥ गर्भे शयानं सुचिरं
> मातुर्गर्भादनिर्गतं । वामदेवं प्रति ब्रूत आद्ययर्चा शतक्रतुः ॥ द्वितीयादिभिरर्धर्चैत्रृषिरत्राह
> पंचभिः । नही स्वस्येति सप्त स्युरर्धर्चा आदितेर्वचः ॥
> ममच्चन त्वा युवतिरित्यचः पंच वै मुनेः । दौर्गत्यशांतिमत्राह वामदेवस्तथांत्यया ॥
> एवमर्थाद्वक्तृभेद इति बह्वृचशासनं । अर्थो विवेकस्पष्टत्वादुपदेशेषु नेरितः ।
> ऋषिदैवतसिद्ध्यर्थं विवेकादर्थ ईरित इति ॥

> *ryā tenocyate sā devateti paribhāṣitatvādṛṣidevate tatra tatra jñātavye | asmin*
> *sūkte iṃdrāditivāmadevasaṃvādarūpiṇī kācidākhyāyikā ślokarūpeṇa sūcyate|*

> *garbhastho jñānasaṃpanno vāmadevo mahāmuniḥ | matiṃ cakre na jāyeya yonideśāttu mātṛtaḥ | kiṃtu pārśvāditaśceti jñātvā nu jananī tvidaṃ | dadhyau śāṃtai*
> *śacīṃ devīmaditiṃ tviṃdramātaraṃ ‖ aditistviṃdrasahitā garbhiṇīmabhyagādvane |*
> *aditīṃdravāmadevāḥ saṃvādamatha cakrire‖ saṃvāda iti sūtreṇa kathā saiṣātra sūcyate|*
> *nokto vaktṛviśeṣo 'tra hyupadeśeśvannuktitaḥ ‖ arthatasvavagaṃtavyo vaktṛbheda*
> *iti sthitiḥ | iṃdroditiryaṣiścāsminmithaḥ sūkte samūcire ‖ garbhè śayānaṃ suciraṃ*
> *māturgarbhādanirgataṃ | vāmadevaṃ prati brūta ādyayarcā śatakratuḥ ‖ dvitīyādibhirardharcairṣiratrāha paṃcabhiḥ | nahī svasyeti sapta syurardharcā ādítervacaḥ ‖*
> *mamaccana tvā yuvatirityacaḥ paṃca vai muneḥ |*
> *daurgatyaśāṃtimatrāha vāmadevastathāṃtyayā ‖*
> *evamarthādvaktṛbheda iti bahvṛcaśāsanaṃ | artho vivekaspaṣṭatvādupadeśeṣu neritaḥ | ṛṣidaivatasiddhyarthaṃ vivekādartha īrita iti ‖*

Gist of the bhāṣya

Sāyaṇa continues the Anukramaṇikā statement. The seer is the one whose speech a ṛk is, and the deity is the one of whom it speaks. Since this is the established rule, the seers and deities are to be understood verse by verse. In this sūkta a certain narrative, a dialogue between Indra, Aditi and Vāmadeva, is indicated in the form of verses (ślokas). While still in the womb, the knowing great sage Vāmadeva made up his mind: "I will not be born from my mother's birth-passage, but from her side." His mother learned of this and meditated, for her protection, on the goddess Śacī and on Aditi, the mother of Indra. Aditi went with Indra to the pregnant woman in the forest, and Aditi, Indra and Vāmadeva then held a conversation. The sūtra "saṃvādaḥ" indicates this story. The speaker is not named in the teaching, and the difference of speakers must be understood from the sense. Indra, Aditi and the seer spoke to one another in this sūkta. With the first ṛk Indra addresses Vāmadeva, who has lain long in the womb and not yet come out of it. With five half-verses from the second onward the seer speaks. The seven half-verses beginning "nahī nvasya" are Aditi's speech. The five ṛks beginning "mamaccana tvā yuvatiḥ" belong to the sage[?464]. With the last ṛk Vāmadeva speaks the pacification of misfortune. The speakers are thus known from the sense, as the Bahvṛca teaching says; the sense is not stated in the teachings because it is clear from discernment, and it is given here to establish the seers and deities.

Anuvāda

This sūkta beginning "ayaṃ panthāḥ" is the eighth sūkta of the second anuvāka. It has thirteen ṛks; the metre is Triṣṭup. In the Anukramaṇikā it is said: "ayaṃ panthāḥ saptonā saṃvāda indrāditivāmadevānām", that is, in this sūkta there is a dialogue of Indra, Aditi and the seer Vāmadeva. "Yasya vākyaṃ sa ṛṣiḥ, yā tenocyate sā devatā": the one whose speech is in a ṛk is the seer of that ṛk, and the one whose matter is spoken of in the ṛk is its deity. As this is the established rule, in this sūkta too the seers and deities of the several ṛks are to be inferred according to context. A narrative concerning the conversation of Indra, Aditi and Vāmadeva, spoken of in this sūkta, is given here in verse form:

> गर्भस्थो ज्ञानसंपन्नो वामदेवो महामुनिः ।
> मतिं चक्रे न जायेय योनिदेशात्तु मातृतः ॥ १ ॥
> किंतु पार्श्वादितश्चति ज्ञात्वा नु जननी त्विदं ॥
> दध्यौ शांतै शचीं देवीमदितिं त्विंद्रमातरं ॥ २ ॥
> अदितिस्त्विंद्रसहिता गर्भिणीमभ्यगाद्वने ।
> आदितींद्रवामदेवाः संवादमथ चक्रिरे ॥ ३ ॥
> संवाद इति सूत्रेण कथा सैषात्र सूच्यते ।
> नोक्तो वक्तृविशेषोऽत्र ह्युपदेशेष्वनुक्तितः ॥ ४ ॥

> *garbhastho jñānasaṃpanno vāmadevo mahāmuniḥ |*
> *matiṃ cakre na jāyeya yonideśāttu mātṛtaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*
> *kiṃtu pārśvāditaścati jñātvā nu jananī tvidaṃ ‖*
> *dadhyau śāṃtai śacīṃ devīmaditiṃ tviṃdramātaraṃ ‖ 2 ‖*
> *aditistviṃdrasahitā garbhiṇīmabhyagādvane |*

> *āditīṃdravāmadevāḥ saṃvādamatha cakrire ‖ 3 ‖*
> *saṃvāda iti sūtreṇa kathā saiṣātra sūcyate |*
> *nokto vaktṛviśeṣo 'tra hyupadeśeṣvanuktitaḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

> अर्थतस्त्ववगंतव्यो वक्तृभेद इति स्थितिः ।
> इंद्रोदितिऋषिश्चास्मिन्मिथः सूक्ते समूचिरे ॥ ५ ॥
> गर्भे शयानं सुचिरं मातुर्गर्भादनिर्गतं ।
> नामदेवं प्रति ब्रूत आद्ययर्च शतक्रतुः ॥ ६ ॥
> द्वितीयादिभिरर्धर्चैर्यषिरत्राह पंचभिः
> नही न्वस्येति सप्त स्युरर्धर्चा अदितेर्वचः ॥ ७ ॥
> ममच्चन त्वा युवतिरित्यृचः पंच वै मुनेः ।
> दौर्गत्यशांतिमत्राह नामदेवस्तथांत्यया ॥ ८ ॥
> एवमर्थाद्वक्तृभेद इति बह्वृचशासनात् ।
> अर्थो विवेकस्पष्टत्वादुपदेशेषु नेरितः ॥ ९ ॥
> ऋषिदैवतसिध्यर्थं विवेकादर्थ ईरितः ।
> (अनु. भा. ४–१८).

> *arthatastvavagaṃtavyo vaktṛbheda iti sthitiḥ |*
> *iṃdroditirṣiścāsminmithaḥ sūkte samūcire ‖ 5 ‖*
> *garbhè śayānaṃ suciraṃ māturgarbhādanirgataṃ |*
> *nāmadevaṃ prati brūta ādyayarca śatakratuḥ ‖ 6 ‖*
> *dvitīyādibhirardharcairyaṣiratrāha paṃcabhiḥ*
> *nahī nvasyeti sapta syurardharcā aditervacaḥ ‖ 7 ‖*
> *mamaccana tvā yuvatirityṛcaḥ paṃca vai muneḥ |*
> *daurgatyaśāṃtimatrāha nāmadevastathāṃtyayā ‖ 8 ‖*
> *evamarthādvaktṛbheda iti bahvṛcaśāsanāt |*
> *artho vivekaspaṣṭatvādupadeśeṣu neritaḥ ‖ 9 ‖*
> *ṛṣidaivatasidhyarthaṃ vivekādartha īritaḥ |*
> *(anu. bhā. 4-18).*

?465

The great-souled seer Vāmadeva, while in his mother's womb, thought thus: "If I were now to be born as ordinary people are, coming out through my mother's birth-passage, that would not befit the greatness of one who knows as I do. Therefore, when I come out of the womb, I shall not come by the birth-passage but by cleaving my mother's side." So he resolved. Vāmadeva's mother learned of this and feared that if the child split her flank and came out, death would befall her. To remove this fear she meditated on the goddess Śacī, Indra's wife, and on the goddess Aditi, Indra's mother. Hearing her cry of distress, Aditi came with Indra to the place in the forest where the pregnant woman (Vāmadeva's mother) was. Then a conversation took place between the goddess Aditi, Indra and the seer Vāmadeva in the womb. That very conversation is set forth in this sūkta. It cannot be said precisely who composed the dialogue of this sūkta in sūkta form, but the matter has come down by tradition. Who spoke which words, as stated in the sūkta, is to be understood according to the sense. This sūkta contains the dialogue held among the three, Indra, Aditi and the seer Vāmadeva. In the first ṛk of this sūkta is Indra's speech addressed to the seer Vāmadeva, who has been in his mother's womb for a very long time and has not yet come out (as an infant?). From the second ṛk up to the first half of the fourth is the speech of the seer Vāmadeva; from the latter half of the fourth up to the seventh ṛk is Aditi's speech; in the five ṛks from the eighth to the twelfth is the speech of the pregnant mother of the seer Vāmadeva. In the last ṛk, the thirteenth, is the pacifying mantra spoken by the seer Vāmadeva for the removal of misfortune.

Therefore who the seers and deities are of each ṛk is to be learned from the sense of the respective ṛks. Since the sense stated in the ṛks is clear, it is not repeated here; this explanation had to be given here in order to make the seers and deities clear.

Sūkta 18.

Maṇḍala 4; Anuvāka 2; Sūkta 18.

Aṣṭaka 3; Adhyāya 5; Vargas 25, 26.

Number of ṛks in the sūkta: 13.

Seer: Vāmadeva Gautama (1: Indra; 2, 3 and, in 4, the first half, and 13: Vāmadeva; in 4, the latter half, 5, 6, 7: Aditi; 8, 9, 10, 11, 12: the pregnant mother of Vāmadeva).

Deity: (1: Vāmadeva; 2, 3 and, in 4, the first half: Indra; in 4, the latter half, 5, 6, 7: Vāmadeva; 8, 9, 10, 11, 12: Indra; 13: आत्मशंसा इंद्रो ना (*ātmaśaṃsā iṃdro nā*)[?466].)

Metre: Triṣṭup.

Ṛk 1

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒यं पन्था॒ अनु॑वित्तः पुरा॒णो यतो॑ दे॒वा उ॒दजा॑यन्त॒ विश्वे॑ ।
अत॑श्चि॒दा ज॑निषी॒ष्ट प्रवृ॑द्धो॒ मा मा॒तर॑ममु॒या पत्त॑वे कः ॥ १ ॥

> *ayaṃ panthā anuvittaḥ purāṇo yato devā udajāyanta viśve |*
> *ataścidā janiṣīṣṭa pravṛddho mā mātaramamuyā pattave kaḥ ‖ 1 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अयं । पंथाः । अनुवित्तः । पुराणः । यतः । देवाः । उत् अजायंत । विश्वे ।
> अतः । चित् । आ । जनिषीष्ट । प्रवृद्धः । मा । मातरं । अमुया । पत्तवे। करिति कः॥

> *ayaṃ | paṃthāḥ | anuvittaḥ | purāṇaḥ | yataḥ | devāḥ | ut ajāyaṃta | viśve |*
> *ataḥ | cit | ā | janiṣīṣṭa | pravṛddhaḥ | mā | mātaraṃ | amuyā | pattave| kariti kaḥ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> इंद्रवाक्यं । पुराणोऽनादिरयु प्रत्यक्षेणोपलभ्यमानः पंथा योनिर्निगमनरूपो मार्गोऽनु आनुपूर्व्येण वित्तः । सर्वैर्जायमानैर्लब्धः ।
> यतो यस्माद्योनिमार्गाद्विश्वे सर्वे देवा उदजायंत । उत्कर्षेणोत्पन्ना भवंति । तस्माद्योनिमार्गान्मनुष्या उत्पन्ना भवंतीति किमु वक्तव्यं । अतश्चिदस्माद्योनिमार्गादेव प्रवृद्यो गर्भे प्रकर्षेण वृद्धिं गतो वामदेव आ जनिषीष्ट ।
> आ समंताच्चायतां । अमुयानूं मातरं पत्तवे पतनाय । मरणायेत्यर्थः ।
> मा कः । मा करोतु ॥

> *iṃdravākyaṃ | purāṇo 'nādirayu pratyakṣeṇopalabhyamānaḥ paṃthā yonirnigamanarūpo mārgo 'nu ānupūrvyeṇa vittaḥ |*
> *sarvairjāyamānairlabdhaḥ |*

> *yato yasmādyonimārgādviśve sarvè devā udajāyaṃta | utkarṣeṇotpannā bhavaṃti | tasmādyonimārgānmanuṣyā utpannā bhavaṃtīti kimu vaktavyaṃ | ataścidasmādyonimārgādeva pravṛdyo garbhe prakarṣeṇa vṛddhiṃ gato vāmadeva ā janiṣīṣṭa |*
> *ā samaṃtāccāyatāṃ | amuyānūṃ mātaraṃ pattave patanāya |*
> *maraṇāyetyarthaḥ |*
> *mā kaḥ | mā karotu ‖*

Summary

Indra's speech. This path, beginningless, perceived directly, namely the birth-passage, the way of exit, has been found in due succession by all who are born. Since all the gods are born excellently from that very birth-passage, what need is there to say that men are born from it? Therefore from this very path let Vāmadeva, who has grown forth in the womb, be born; "ā" means completely, let him be born. As for this mother, "pattave" means for falling, that is, for death; "mā kaḥ": let him not bring it about.

Word-to-word meaning

- यतः (*yataḥ*)—by which path in the form of the womb
- विश्वे देवाः (*viśve devāḥ*)—all the gods also
- उदजायंत (*udajāyaṃta*)—were born; (by such a path)
- अयं पंथाः (*ayaṃ paṃthāḥ*)—this path of emergence from the womb, in the form of the birth-passage
- पुराणः (*purāṇaḥ*)—as beginningless
- अनु (*anu*)—from of old
- वित्तः (*vittaḥ*)—is a matter known to all
- अतश्चित् (*ataśvit*)—therefore indeed
- प्रवृद्धः (*pravṛddhaḥ*)—Vāmadeva, fully grown in the womb itself
- आ जनिषीष्ट (*ā janiṣīṣṭa*)—let him, obtaining worldly birth, come out of the womb
- अमुया मातरं (*amuyā mātaraṃ*)—this his mother
- सत्तवे (*sattave*)—so as to be subject to death[?467]
- मा कः (*mā kaḥ*)—let him not do

Gist

Indra's speech: this path of emergence from the womb, in the form of the birth-passage, by which all the gods also were born, is known to all as the beginningless place of birth for gods, men and the rest. Therefore let Vāmadeva, who has grown fully in the womb itself, obtain worldly birth and come out of the womb, and let him not bring about the death of this his mother.

English translation

Indra speaks.—This is the old and recognized path by which all the gods are born ; so, when full-grown, let him be born in the same manner ; let him not cause the loss of this his mother.

Special Topics

This sūkta contains the history of the birth of the seer Vāmadeva. Because Vāmadeva was already a great knower while in his mother's womb, he did not wish to come out through the birth-passage as ordinary people are born, but desired to come out by cleaving the side of his mother's body. His mother, who was pregnant and knew this, in fear that death would befall her, meditated on Indra's wife and on the goddess Aditi, Indra's mother, and took refuge in them. Then Aditi came with Indra to Vāmadeva's mother in the hermitage in the forest, pacified Vāmadeva in the womb, and spoke words of good counsel that he should give up his unnatural desire. First Indra speaks, addressing Vāmadeva.

Indra (addressing Vāmadeva in the womb): "O Vāmadeva, all gods and men, when they are born, that is, when they come out of the mother's womb, come only by the mother's birth-passage. The woman's birth-passage is the place of origin of the whole class of living beings. This is the path ordained by nature. If you leave this order and come by cleaving your mother's side, your mother will die. Therefore do not do so."

Vāmadeva (in the womb): "O Indra, I will not come out by this most painful passage of a woman. I will make a way through my mother's side and come out. For I am not like ordinary people; my greatness is surpassing. Many great deeds have to be done by me. Without anyone else's help I can fight an enemy alone. I alone can debate with an adversary. Indra (you, Indra) has just said that if I do not come out by the mother's birth-passage but by another way, my mother will die. But what value can be put on Indra's word? Has that Indra not done many improper acts? Did he not go uninvited to Tvaṣṭṛ's house and forcibly drink the soma juice that had been bought at great cost? Indra's mother Aditi bore Indra in her womb for thousands of months and gave birth to him with great hardship. Yet all the deeds that Indra has done are against the world. Therefore I need not bow to Indra's word. I will come out of my mother's womb as I please."

Aditi: "O Vāmadeva, you should not speak slightingly of Indra. Among all the gods who have so far been born in the world and who will be born hereafter, none is equal to Indra. Thinking that it would not befit his dignity to bear Indra like an ordinary infant in the lying-in chamber, Aditi gave Indra surpassing power. By that power Indra stood forth manifest by his own radiance, and by his surpassing power he pervaded heaven and earth completely. All the rivers that flow on the earth, beginning with the sound अलला (*alalā*) and making a joyous noise, flow on, upholding and proclaiming Indra's greatness.

O seer Vāmadeva, question those rivers and ask. Without Indra's help, how would the waters have come to those rivers from the clouds? Moreover, the nivid-utterances all concern Indra and are purely laudatory. The waters bear Indra's sin of brahmin-slaying in the form of foam. My son Indra slew Vṛtra with the thunderbolt and caused the waters that he had held back to fall on the earth as rain and flow as rivers. Can you reject the word of an Indra of such great nature?"

Vāmadeva (ironically, addressing Indra): "O Indra, did not your young mother (Aditi) bear you with joy? Was it not with joy that the demoness Kuṣavā swallowed you? You broke through that demoness with joy and came out. Through you joy came to the waters too. Was it not from excess of joy as well that the demon Vyaṃsa struck you, slapping you on the cheek? But you, struck by him, grew greater than he, smote his head with the thunderbolt and crushed it to bits. All these are your valorous deeds. Even so your greatness cannot be thought small. As a well-nourished cow obtains an excellent calf?[468], your mother Aditi obtained you (Indra): of surpassing strength, unconquered by enemies, fulfiller of all wishes, impeller of all, able to protect yourself, moving at will. Then, when Aditi asked you, 'O Indra, my son, have Agni and the other gods abandoned your friendship?', you said to Viṣṇu, who was there: 'O friend Viṣṇu, you are all-pervading and my friend; show great valour to slay the asura Vṛtra.' Did you not say so? Besides, you seized your father by the foot, dragged him and killed him, and made your mother a widow. Can anyone else do this deed? Whether lying down or moving about, no one can kill you. Which other gods have strength and power equal to yours, or greater than yours?"

Ṛk 2

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

नाहमतो॒ निरं॑या दु॒र्गहै॒तत्तिं॑र॒श्चता॑ पा॒र्श्वान्निर्गं॑माणि ।
ब॒हूनिं॑ मे॒ अकृं॑ता॒ कर्त्वां॑नि॒ युध्यैं॑ त्वेन॒ सं त्वें॑न पृच्छै ॥ २ ॥

> *nāhamato nirayā durgahaitattiraścatā pārśvānnirgamāṇi |*
> *bahūni me akṛtā kartvāni yudhyai tvena saṃ tvena pṛcchai ‖ 2 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> न । अहं । अतः । निः । अय । दुःगहा । एतत् । तिरश्चता । पार्श्वात् । निः । गमानि ।
> बहूनि । मे । अकृता । कर्त्वानि । युध्यै । त्वेन । सं । त्वेन । पृच्छै ॥ २ ॥

> *na | ahaṃ | ataḥ | niḥ | aya | duḥgahā | etat | tiraścatā | pārśvāt | niḥ | gamāni |*
> *bahūni | me | akṛtā | kartvāni | yudhyai | tvena | saṃ | tvena | pṛcchai ‖ 2 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> वामदेव एवमुक्तवंतमिंद्रं प्रत्याह । अहमतो योनिमार्गान्न निरया।
> न निरयाणि । न निर्गच्छानि । एतद्योनिनिगमरूपं वर्त्म दुर्गहा । दुर्ग्रहं ।
> दुःखेन ग्राह्यं । न प्राप्यं भवतीत्यर्थः । किंतु तिरश्चता तिरश्चीनात्पार्श्वान्निर्गमानि ।
> निर्गच्छानि । योनिदेशादनिर्गतोऽहं पार्श्वं भित्त्वा निर्गच्छानीत्यर्थः । अन्यैरकृतमिदमेव न
> केवलं मया क्रियते किंत्वनैरकृतानि बहूनि कर्माणि मे
> कर्त्वानि कर्तव्यानि संति । त्वेनैकेन सपत्नेन विवदमानेन सह युध्ये । युद्धं
> करवाणि । त्वेनैकेन बुभुत्तुना सं पृच्छै । सम्यक् पृच्छानि ॥

> *vāmadeva evamuktavaṃtamiṃdraṃ pratyāha | ahamato yonimārgānna nirayā|*
> *na nirayāṇi | na nirgacchāni | etadyoninigamarūpaṃ vartma durgahā | durgrahaṃ |*
> *duḥkhena grāhyaṃ | na prāpyaṃ bhavatītyarthaḥ | kiṃtu tiraścatā tiraścīnātpārśvānnirgamāni |*
> *nirgacchāni | yonideśādanirgato 'haṃ pārśvaṃ bhittvā nirgacchānītyarthaḥ | annyairakṛtamidameva na kevalaṃ mayā kriyate kiṃtvanairakṛtāni bahūni karmāṇi me*
> *kartvāni kartavyāni saṃti | tvenaikena sapatnena vivadamānena saha yudhyè | yuddhaṃ*
> *karavāṇi | tvenaikena bubhuttunā saṃ pṛcchai | samyak pṛcchāni ‖*

Summary

Vāmadeva replies to Indra, who has spoken in this way. "From this path of the womb I shall not go out (निरया (*nirayā*) means I shall not go out, I shall not depart). This path of leaving the womb is दुर्गहा (*durgahā*): hard to grasp, hard to take hold of, that is, not to be attained. Rather I shall go out from the slanting side." He means that he will not leave through the place of birth but will split the side and come out. "Not only this is done by me, which others have not done: many deeds are to be done by me which others have not done. I shall fight with one rival who disputes with me. I shall question thoroughly (सं पृच्छै (*saṃ pṛcchai*), 'may I question well') with one who wishes to know (बुभुत्तुना (*bubhuttunā*))."[?469]

Word-to-word meaning

- अहं (*ahaṃ*)—I
- अतः (*ataḥ*)—from this path in the form of the womb
- न निरया (*na nirayā*)—I shall not come out
- एतत् (*etat*)—this path
- दुर्गहा (*durgahā*)—is exceedingly painful
- तिरश्चता (*tiraścatā*)—slanting
- पार्श्वत् (*pārśvat*)—by the side path
- निर्गमानि (*nirgamāni*)—I shall come out
- अकृत (*akṛta*)—not done by others
- बहूनि (*bahūni*)—many deeds
- कर्त्वानि (*kartvāni*)—are to be done by me
- तैन (*taina*)—with a single enemy
- युध्ये (*yudhyè*)—I can fight
- तैन (*taina*)—with a single opponent
- संप्रच्छै (*saṃpracchai*)—I can debate

Gist

The words of the sage Vāmadeva, who is in the womb: "I shall not come out by this path in the form of the womb. This path is exceedingly painful. I shall come out by the slanting side path. Many deeds not done by others are to be done by me. I can fight with a single enemy. I can debate with a single opponent."

English translation

Vamadeva speaks—Let me not come forth by this path, for it is difficult (of issue): let me come forth obliquely from the side : many acts unperformed by others are to be accomplished by me : let me contend (in war) with one (enemy), in controversy with one opponent.

Ṛk 3

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

प॒रा॒य॒तीं मा॒तर॒मन्व॑चष्ट॒ न नानु॑ गा॒न्यनु॒ नू ग॑मानि ।
त्वष्टु॑र्गृ॒हे अ॑पिब॒त्सोम॒मिन्द्र॑ः शतध॒न्य॑ं च॒म्वो॑ः सु॒तस्य॑ं ॥ ३ ॥

> *parāyatīṃ mātaramanvacaṣṭa na nānu gānyanu nū gamāni |*
> *tvaṣṭurgṛhe apibatsomamindraḥ śatadhanyaṃ camvoḥ sutasya ‖ 3 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> परायतीं । मातरं । अनु । अचष्ट । न । न । अनु । गानि । अनु । नु । गमानि ।
> त्वष्टुः । गृहे । अपिबत् । सोमं । इंद्रः । शतधन्यं । चव्वोः । सुतस्य ॥ ३ ॥

> *parāyatīṃ | mātaraṃ | anu | acaṣṭa | na | na | anu | gāni | anu | nu | gamāni |*
> *tvaṣṭuḥ | gṛhe | apibat | somaṃ | iṃdraḥ | śatadhanyaṃ | cavvoḥ | sutasya ‖ 3 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> मयि गर्भस्थिते सतींद्रो मदीयां मातरं परायतीं परेतां म्रियमाणामन्वचष्ट । अन्वब्रवीत् । एवमपीदानीं गर्भे स्थितोऽहं पुराणं पंथानं
> न नानु गानि । नानुगच्छानीति न । किंतु नु क्षिप्रमनु गमानि । अनुगच्छान्येव ।
> वामदेवः स्वकीयमकृत्यकारित्वं परिहृत्येंद्रस्याकृत्यकारित्वमुत्तरार्धर्चेन प्रतिपादयति ।
> इंद्रश्चन्वोः सोमाभिषवफलकयोः सुतस्य सोमं सुतवतोऽभिसुतवतस्त्वष्टुः संबंधिनि गृहेऽनुपहूतः सन् शतधन्यं बहुधनेन क्रीतं सोममपिबत् । बलात्कारेण सोमस्य पानं कृतवान् । अयमर्थस्तृत्तरीयैस्त्वष्टा हतपुत्रो वींद्रं सोममाहरदित्यनुवाके । तै. सं. २-४-१२ । महता प्रबंधेन
> प्रपंचितः ॥

> *mayi garbhasthite satīṃdro madīyāṃ mātaraṃ parāyatīṃ paretāṃ mriyamāṇāmanvacaṣṭa | anvabravīt | evamapīdānīṃ garbhe sthito 'haṃ purāṇaṃ paṃthānaṃ*

> *na nānu gāni | nānugacchānīti na | kiṃtu nu kṣipramanu gamāni | anugacchānyeva |*
> *vāmadevaḥ svakīyamakṛtyakāritvaṃ parihṛtyeṃdrasyākṛtyakāritvamuttarārdharcena pratipādayati | iṃdraścanvoḥ somābhiṣavaphalakayoḥ sutasya somaṃ sutavato 'bhisutavatastvaṣṭuḥ saṃbaṃdhini gṛhe 'nupahūtaḥ san śatadhanyaṃ bahudhanena krītaṃ somamapibat | balātkāreṇa somasya pānaṃ kṛtavān | ayamarthastṛttarīyaistvaṣṭā hataputro vīṃdraṃ somamāharadityanuvāke | tai. saṃ. 2-4-12 | mahatā prabaṃdhena prapaṃcitaḥ ||*

Summary

While I am in the womb, Indra spoke to my mother, who was departing (परायतीं (*parāyatīṃ*)), that is, dying. Even now, though I am in the womb, he says I shall not follow the old path: न नानु गानि (*na nānu gāni*), meaning "I would not follow", and yet नु (*nu*), quickly, अनु गमानि (*anu gamāni*), "I shall indeed follow".?470

Setting aside his own improper acting, Vāmadeva shows Indra's improper acting in the latter half of the verse. In the house of Tvaṣṭṛ, who had pressed Soma at the two pressing-boards (चन्वोः (*canvoḥ*)), Indra, uninvited, drank the Soma bought with much wealth (शतधन्यं (*śatadhanyaṃ*)). He drank the Soma by force. This matter is set out at length in the anuvāka beginning त्वष्टा हतपुत्रो वींद्रं सोममाहरदित्यनुवाके(*tvaṣṭā hataputro vīṃdraṃ somamāharadityanuvāke*) (Tai. Saṃ. 2-4-12).

Word-to-word meaning

- मातरं (*mātaraṃ*)—my mother
- परायतीं (*parāyatīṃ*)—that she is about to die
- अन्वचष्ट (*anvacaṣṭa*)—(Indra) has said
- न नानु गानि (*na nānu gāni*)—I shall not follow the ancient path (but)
- नु (*nu*)—very soon
- अनु गमानि (*anu gamāni*)—I shall come out just as I wish
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- चन्वोः (*canvos*)—in the Soma vessels

- सुतस्य (*sutasya*)—which had been pressed
- शतधन्वं (*śatadhanvaṃ*)—bought with much wealth
- सोमं (*somaṃ*)—the Soma
- त्वष्टुः (*tvaṣṭuḥ*)—of Tvaṣṭṛ
- गृहे (*gṛhe*)—in the house
- अपिबत् (*apibat*)—(went there uninvited and) drank

Gist

Indra has told me that if I do not follow the ancient path, in the form of the womb, for coming out of the womb, my mother will die. But I shall not follow that path

but shall come out quickly, just as I wish. In the house of Tvaṣṭṛ, Indra went uninvited and drank by force the Soma that had been pressed in the Soma vessels and bought with much wealth. (That too was an improper act.)

English translation

He, (Indra), has asserted that it will) cause the death of my mother : let me not proceed by the usual way, but proceed quickly, according (to my will): in the dwelling of Twashtri, Indra drank the costly Soma from the vessels of the offerers.

Special Topics

We have already described at length earlier how Indra forcibly drank Soma in the house of Tvaṣṭṛ.

Ṛk 4

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

किं स ऋध॑क्कृणव॒द्यं स॒हस्रं॑ मा॒सो ज॒भार॑ श॒रद॑श्च
पू॒र्वीः ।
न॒ही न्व॑स्य प्रति॒मान॒मस्त्य॒न्तर्जा॒तेषू॒त ये जनि॑त्वाः
॥ ४ ॥

> *kiṃ sa ṛdhakkṛṇavadyaṃ sahasraṃ māso jabhāra śaradaśca pūrvīḥ |*
> *nahī nvasya pratimānamastyantarjāteṣūta ye janitvāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> किं । सः । ऋधक् । कृणवत् । यं । सहस्रं । मासः । जभार । शरदः । च । पूर्वीः ।
> नहि । नु । अस्य । प्रतिमानं । अस्ति । अंतः । जातेषु । उत । ये । जिनित्वाः ॥ ४ ॥

> *kiṃ | saḥ | ṛdhak | kṛṇavat | yaṃ | sahasraṃ | māsaḥ | jabhāra | śaradaḥ | ca | pūrvīḥ |*
> *nahi | nu | asya | pratimānaṃ | asti | aṃtaḥ | jāteṣu | uta | ye | jinitvāḥ ‖ 4 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अदितिर्यमिंद्रं सहस्रं बहून्मासो मासान्नूर्विर्बह्वीः शरदश्च संवत्सरांश्च जभार । बभार ॥ बिभर्तेरिदं रूपं ॥ गर्भे स्थित इंद्रो बहुषु संवत्सरेष्पदितिं क्लेशितवानित्यर्थः । एवंभूतः स इंद्रः किं यत्किमपि । सर्वमपीत्यर्थः ।
> ऋधक् विरुद्धं कर्म कृणवत् । अकरोत् । इंद्रस्याक्षेपमसहमानादितिरिंद्रमाताप्येनं प्रति ब्रूते । हे वामदेव जातेषूत्पन्नेषु देवादिष्टंतर्मध्ये:–

> *aditiryamiṃdraṃ sahasraṃ bahūnmāso māsānnūrvirbahvīḥ śaradaśca saṃvatsarāṃśca jabhāra | babhāra ‖ bibharteridaṃ rūpaṃ ‖ garbhe sthita iṃdro bahuṣu saṃvatsareṣpaditiṃ kleśitavānityarthaḥ | evaṃbhūtaḥ sa iṃdraḥ kiṃ yatkimapi | sarvamapītyarthaḥ |*
> *ṛdhak viruddhaṃ karma kṛṇavat | akarot | iṃdrasyākṣepamasahamānāditiriṃdramātāpyenaṃ prati brūte | he vāmadeva jāteṣūtpanneṣu devādiṣṭaṃtarmadhyè:-*

> स्येंद्रस्य प्रतिमानं न ह्यस्ति । न विद्यते खलु । नु इति पादपूरणार्थः । उतापि च
> ये देवादयो जनित्वा जनयितव्या जनयिष्यमाणास्तेषु मध्येऽसेंद्रस्य प्रतिमानं नास्ति ॥

> *syeṃdrasya pratimānaṃ na hyasti | na vidyate khalu | nu iti pādapūraṇārthaḥ | utāpi ca*
> *ye devādayo janitvā janayitavyā janayiṣyamāṇāsteṣu madhye 'seṃdrasya pratimānaṃ nāsti ‖*

Summary

Aditi bore Indra for a thousand (that is, many) months (मासः (*māsaḥ*)) and many autumns, that is, years: जभार (*jabhāra*) is the same as बभार (*babhāra*), a form of the root bhṛ. The meaning is that Indra, while in the womb, distressed Aditi for many years. Such an Indra, whatever (किं (*kiṃ*), meaning everything) ऋधक् (*ṛdhak*), contrary action he did, कृणवत् (*kṛṇavat*), he performed. Aditi, Indra's mother, cannot bear the reproach against Indra and answers Vāmadeva: "O Vāmadeva, among those who are born, gods and others, within them (the bhāṣya continues on the next page)

there is indeed no match for Indra. नु (*nu*) is a mere metrical filler. And among those, gods and others, who are to be born or will be born, there is no match for Indra."

Word-to-word meaning

- यं (*yaṃ*)—whom (Indra) (Aditi)
- सहस्रं मासः (*sahasraṃ māsaḥ*)—for thousands of months
- पूर्विः शरदः (*pūrviḥ śaradaḥ*)—for many years
- जुभार (*jubhāra*)—she bore in the womb
- सः (*saḥ*)—that Indra
- किं (*kiṃ*)—whatever act
- कृणवत् (*kṛṇavat*)—he did
- ऋधक् (*ṛdhak*)—that is wholly and altogether contrary to the world
- जातेषु (*jāteṣu*)—(O Vāmadeva) among those who have been born
- उत (*uta*)—and
- ये (*ye*)—who
- जनित्वाः (*janitvāḥ*)—will be born in future, among all such gods

- अंतः (*aṃtaḥ*)—in the midst
- अस्य (*asya*)—for this Indra
- प्रतिमानं (*pratimānaṃ*)—a comparison (those equal to him)
- नहि अस्ति (*nahi asti*)—there is none at all

Gist

Whatever deeds are done by Indra, whom his mother carried in the womb for thousands of months and many years, are all contrary to the world. Aditi's words: "O Vāmadeva, among all the gods who have been born and will be born, there is no one equal to Indra."

English translation

Aditi speaks.—What irregular act has he committed whom (I, his mother,) bore for a thousand months and for many years? there is no analogy between him and those who have been or will be born.

Ṛk 5

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अ॒व॒द्यमि॑व॒ मन्य॑माना॒ गुहा॑क॒रिन्द्रं॑ मा॒ता वी॒र्ये॑णा॒ न्यृ॑ष्टम् ।
अथोद॑स्थात्स्व॒यमत्कं॒ वसा॑न॒ आ रोद॑सी अपृणा॒ज्ञाय॑मानः ॥ ५ ॥

> *avadyamiva manyamānā guhākarindraṃ mātā vīryeṇā nyṛṣṭam |*
> *athodasthātsvayamatkaṃ vasāna ā rodasī apṛṇājjāyamānaḥ ‖ 5 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> दद्यं इव । मन्यमाना । गुहा । अकः । इंद्रं । माता । वीर्येण । निऋष्टं ।

> *dadyaṃ iva | manyamānā | guhā | akaḥ | iṃdraṃ | mātā | vīryeṇa | nirṣṭaṃ |*

> अथ । उत् । अस्थात् । स्वयं । अत्यं । वसानः । आ । रोदसी इति । अपृणात् ।
> जायमानः ॥

> *atha | ut | asthāt | svayaṃ | atyaṃ | vasānaḥ | ā | rodasī iti | apṛṇāt |*
> *jāyamānaḥ ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> गुहा गुहायां गह्वररूपे सूतिकागृहे जातमिंद्रमवद्यमिव गर्हमिव मन्यमाना जानती
> मातेंद्रजनन्यदितिर्वीर्येण सामर्थ्येन नृष्टं नितरां
> प्राप्तमकः । अकरोत् । अथानंतरं जायमान उत्पद्यमान इंद्रः स्वयमेवात्कं
> तेजो वसान आच्छादकः सन् । दधान इत्यर्थः । उदस्थात् । उत्कर्षेणातिष्ठत् ।
> किंच रोदसी द्यानापृथिव्यावापृणात् । समंतात्पूरयामास ॥

> *guhā guhāyāṃ gahvararūpe sūtikāgṛhe jātamiṃdramavadyamiva*
> *garhamiva manyamānā jānatī māteṃdrajananyaditirvīryeṇa*
> *sāmarthyena nṛṣṭaṃ nitarāṃ*
> *prāptamakaḥ | akarot | athānaṃtaraṃ jāyamāna utpadyamāna iṃdraḥ*
> *svayamevātkaṃ*
> *tejo vasāna ācchādakaḥ san | dadhāna ityarthaḥ | udasthāt |*
> *utkarṣeṇātiṣṭhat |*
> *kiṃca rodasī dyānāpṛthivyāvāpṛṇāt | samaṃtātpūrayāmāsa ‖*

Summary

Indra was born in the cave-like lying-in room (गुहा (*guhā*)). His mother Aditi, considering it blameworthy (अवद्यमिव (*avadyamiva*)), made him नृष्टं (*nṛṣṭaṃ*), that is, fully endowed, with strength (वीर्येण (*vīryeṇa*)). Thereafter, Indra, being born, rose up by himself, clothed in अत्कं (*atkaṃ*), that is, splendour, and covering himself with it. Further, he filled रोदसी (*rodasī*), heaven and earth, on all sides.

Word-to-word meaning

- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- गुहा (*guhā*)—to give birth in the concealment of the lying-in room
- अवद्यं इव (*avadyaṃ iva*)—(befitting his greatness) is not a praiseworthy act
- मन्यमाना (*manyamānā*)—having thought

- माता (*mātā*)—Aditi, Indra's mother
- वीर्येण (*vīryeṇa*)—with extraordinary strength
- नृष्टं (*nṛṣṭaṃ*)—as one endowed
- अकः (*akaḥ*)—she made
- अथ (*atha*)—afterwards
- जायमानः (*jāyamānaḥ*)—Indra, who was born
- स्वयं (*svayaṃ*)—his own
- अत्कं (*atkaṃ*)—splendour
- वसानः (*vasānaḥ*)—having put on
- उदस्थात् (*udasthāt*)—rose up mightily
- रोदसी (*rodasī*)—in both heaven and earth
- आ अपृणात् (*ā apṛṇāt*)—pervaded completely

Gist

Aditi, Indra's mother, considered that to give birth to Indra in the concealment of the lying-in room was not an act befitting his dignity, and made him endowed with extraordinary strength. Thereafter Indra, who was born, rose up clothed in his own splendour, and at once pervaded heaven and earth completely.

English translation

Deeming it disreputable (that he should be brought forth) in secret. his mother endowed (Indra) with (extraordinary) vigour : therefore, as soon as born he sprung up of his own accord, invested with splendour, and filled both heaven and earth.

Ṛk 6

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ए॒ता अ॑र्षन्त्यल॒लाभव॑न्तीरृ॒ताव॑रीरिव सं॒क्रोश॑मानाः ।
ए॒ता वि पृ॑च्छ॒ किमि॒दं भ॑नन्ति॒ कमापो॒ अद्रिं॑ परि॒
धिं रु॑जन्ति ॥ ६ ॥

> *etā arṣantyalalābhavantīrṛtāvarīriva saṃkrośamānāḥ |*
> *etā vi pṛccha kimidaṃ bhananti kamāpo adriṃ paridhiṃ rujanti ‖ 6 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> एताः । अर्षंति । अललाभवंतीः । ऋतवरीःइव । संक्रोषमानाः ।
> एताः । वि । पृच्छ । किं । इदं । भनंति । कं । आपः । अद्रिं । परिधिं । रुजंति ॥ ६ ॥

> *etāḥ | arṣaṃti | alalābhavaṃtīḥ | ṛtavarīḥiva | saṃkroṣamānāḥ |*
> *etāḥ | vi | pṛccha | kiṃ | idaṃ | bhanaṃti | kaṃ | āpaḥ | adriṃ |*
> *paridhiṃ | rujaṃti ‖ 6 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अललाभवंतीरललेत्येवंरूपं शब्दं कुर्वत्य ऋतावरीरिवोदकवत्य एवैता
> नद्यः संक्रोशमाना इंद्रमहत्त्वप्रतिपादकोद्भूतेन हर्षण बहुविधं शब्दायमानाः सत्योऽर्षंति ।
> गच्छंति । एवंभूता नद्य इदं किं भनंति शोत्रग्राह्यं
> शब्दायमानं किं वदंतीमनुर्थं हे ऋषे त्वमेता नदीर्वि पृच्छ । विशेषेण
> पृष्टवान् भव । एवं संपृच्छ । विचारिते सत्येतच्छब्दायमानमिंद्रमाहात्मस्यैव
> वचनं भवतीत्यर्थः । किंच आप उदकानि परिधिमावरकं कमद्रिं कं मेघं रुजंति ।
> भंजंति । आपः कमपि मेघं न भंजंति किंतु इंद्रो मम पुत्र एवोदकावरकं
> मेघं भक्त्वापः प्रवर्तयतीत्यर्थः ॥

> *alalābhavaṃtīralaletyevaṃrūpaṃ śabdaṃ kurvatya*
> *ṛtāvarīrivodakavatya evaitā*
> *nadyaḥ saṃkrośamānā iṃdramahattvapratipādakodbhūtena harṣaṇa*
> *bahuvidhaṃ śabdāyamānāḥ satyo 'rṣaṃti | gacchaṃti | evaṃbhūtā*
> *nadya idaṃ kiṃ bhanaṃti śotragrāhyaṃ*
> *śabdāyamānaṃ kiṃ vadaṃtīmanurthaṃ he ṛṣe tvametā nadīrvi pṛccha |*
> *viśeṣeṇa*
> *pṛṣṭavān bhava | evaṃ saṃpṛccha | vicārite*
> *satyetacchabdāyamānamiṃdramāhātmasyaiva*
> *vacanaṃ bhavatītyarthaḥ | kiṃca āpa udakāni paridhimāvarakaṃ*
> *kamadriṃ kaṃ meghaṃ rujaṃti |*
> *bhaṃjaṃti | āpaḥ kamapi meghaṃ na bhaṃjaṃti kiṃtu iṃdro mama*
> *putra evodakāvarakaṃ*
> *meghaṃ bhaktvāpaḥ pravartayatītyarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

अललाभवंतीः (*alalābhavaṃtīḥ*) means making a sound of the form "alala". Like ऋतावरीः (*ṛtāvarīḥ*), that is, full of water, these very rivers, संक्रोशमानाः (*saṃkrośamānāḥ*), resounding in many ways with the joy that has arisen from proclaiming Indra's greatness, flow (अर्षंति (*arṣaṃti*)). "What do these rivers say (भनंति (*bhanaṃti*)), what is this audible sound? O sage, question these rivers closely (वि पृच्छ (*vi pṛccha*))." The meaning is that, when asked, this sound proves to be a statement of Indra's greatness itself. Further, the waters break (रुजंति (*rujaṃti*)) which cloud (कमद्रिं कं मेघं (*kamadriṃ kaṃ meghaṃ*)), the encloser (परिधिं (*paridhiṃ*))? The waters do not break any cloud. Rather, my son Indra himself breaks the cloud that encloses the waters and sets the waters in motion.

Word-to-word meaning

- अललाभवंतीः (*alalābhavaṃtīḥ*)—making the sound अलला (*alalā*) and the like
- ऋतावरीः इव (*ṛtāvarīḥ iva*)—as if full of water
- एताः (*etāḥ*)—these rivers
- संक्रोशमानाः (*saṃkrośamānāḥ*)—accompanied by sounds of joy (proclaiming Indra's greatness)
- अर्षंति (*arṣaṃti*)—flow
- इदं किं भनंति (*idaṃ kiṃ bhanaṃti*)—(O sage) what is the meaning of this audible sound of theirs
- एताः (*etāḥ*)—these rivers
- वि पृच्छ (*vi pṛccha*)—ask, questioning
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters
- परिधिं (*paridhiṃ*)—the encloser
- कं अद्रिं (*kaṃ adriṃ*)—which cloud
- रुजंति (*rujaṃti*)—can they break?

Gist

All these rivers flow, making sounds of joy such as "alala", as if proclaiming Indra's greatness. O sage, ask these rivers themselves what the meaning of this audible sound of theirs is. (Without Indra's help) which enclosing cloud could the waters break?

English translation

These (rivers) flew murmuring as if, being filled with water, they were uttering sounds (of joy) : ask them what is this they say ; what is the encompassing cloud that the waters break through ?

Ṛk 7

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

किमु॑ ष्विदस्मै नि॒विदो॑ भन॒न्तेन्द्र॑स्याव॒द्यं दि॑धिषन्त॒ आप॑◌ः ।
म॒मैता॒न्पु॒त्रो म॑ह॒ता व॒धेन॑ वृ॒त्रं ज॑घ॒न्वाँ अ॑सृ॒ज॒द्वि सिन्धू॑न् ॥ ७ ॥

> *kimu ṣvidasmai nivido bhanantendrasyāvadyaṃ didhiṣanta āpaḥ |*
> *mamaitānputro mahatā vadhena vṛtraṃ jaghanvā~ asṛjadvi sindhūn ‖ 7 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> किं । ऊं इति । स्वित् । अस्मै । निविदः । भनंत । इंद्रस्य । अवद्यं । दिधिषंते । आपः।
> मम । एतान् । पुत्रः । महता । वधेन । वृत्रं । जघन्वान् । असृजत् । वि ।
> सिंधून् ॥ ७ ॥

> *kiṃ | ūṃ iti | svit | asmai | nividaḥ | bhanaṃta | iṃdrasya | avadyaṃ | didhiṣaṃte | āpaḥ|*
> *mama | etān | putraḥ | mahatā | vadhena | vṛtraṃ | jaghanvān | asṛjat | vi |*
> *siṃdhūn ‖ 7 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> यदेंद्रो वृत्रासुरं हतवान् तदा शाश्वतीं ब्रह्महत्यां प्राप्तवानिति वामदेवस्याभिप्रायमुन्नीयादितिराह । निविदः । मरुत्वतीयशस्त्रे प्रयुज्यमानानि
> मरुत्सोत्रो मरुद्धण इत्यादीनींद्रस्तुतिप्रतिपादकानि कानिचित्पदानि निविच्छब्देनोच्यंते । ता निविदोऽस्मा इदुं वृत्रवधनिमित्तं ब्रह्महत्यारूपं पापं प्राप्पुवंतमिंद्रं किमु ष्ट्वित् भनंत । भनंति । किं वदंतीति चेत् । तर्हि । पापरहितमिंद्रं
> मत्वा निविदः स्तुवंति। कथमिंद्रस्य पापरहितत्वं । उच्यते । आपः फेनरूपेणास्येंद्रस्यावद्यं ब्रह्महत्यादिरूपं पापं दिधिषंते । धारयंति । मम पुत्रो मदीयः
> पुत्र इंद्रो महता प्रभूतेन वधेन । वध इति वज्रनामैतत् । वज्रेण वृत्रं जघन्वान् । हतवान् । तत एतान् सिंधूनुदकानि व्यसृजत् । विशेषेण स्वैरत्वेन सर्तुं
> सृष्टवान् । इंद्रेणोत्सृष्टा अपस्तस्य पापं जगृहुरित्यर्थः ॥

> *yadeṃdro vṛtrāsuraṃ hatavān tadā śāśvatīṃ brahmahatyāṃ prāptavāniti vāmadevasyābhiprāyamunnīyāditirāha | nividaḥ | marutvatīyaśastre prayujyamānāni*
> *marutsotro maruddhaṇa ityādīnīṃdrastutipratipādakāni kānicitpadāni nivicchabdenocyaṃte | tā nivido 'smā iduṃ vṛtravadhanimittaṃ brahmahatyārūpaṃ pāpaṃ prāppuvaṃtamiṃdraṃ kimu ṣṭvit bhanaṃta | bhanaṃti | kiṃ vadaṃtīti cet | tarhi | pāparahitamiṃdraṃ*
> *matvā nividaḥ stuvaṃti| kathamiṃdrasya pāparahitatvaṃ | ucyate | āpaḥ phenarūpeṇāsyeṃdrasyāvadyaṃ brahmahatyādirūpaṃ pāpaṃ didhiṣaṃte | dhārayaṃti | mama putro madīyaḥ*
> *putra iṃdro mahatā prabhūtena vadhena | vadha iti vajranāmaitat | vajreṇa vṛtraṃ jaghanvān | hatavān | tata etān siṃdhūnudakāni vyasṛjat | viśeṣeṇa svairatvena sartuṃ*
> *sṛṣṭavān | iṃdreṇotsṛṣṭā apastasya pāpaṃ jagṛhurityarthaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says that Vāmadeva speaks inferring that when Indra killed the demon Vṛtra he incurred the eternal sin of brahmin-slaying. निविदः (*nividaḥ*): certain phrases used in the Marutvatīya recitation, such as "Marut-stotra, Marud-gaṇa", which express praise of Indra, are called nivid. What do these nivids say of this Indra, who has incurred the sin of brahmin-slaying through the killing of Vṛtra? If it is asked what they say: they praise Indra as one free of sin. How is Indra free of sin? It is answered: the waters, in the form of foam, bear this blemish of Indra, the sin of brahmin-slaying and the like.

"My son", that is, Indra, my own son, with a great, abundant वध (*vadha*) (vadha is a name of the thunderbolt) slew Vṛtra. Then he released these rivers, the waters, letting them flow freely and as they please. The meaning is that the waters released by Indra took his sin upon themselves.

Word-to-word meaning

- निविदः (*nividaḥ*)—these mantras in the form of 'nivid'
- अस्मै (*asmai*)—concerning this Indra
- किमु स्वित् (*kimu svit*)—what indeed
- भनंत (*bhanaṃta*)—they say (they merely praise him)
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters
- इंद्रस्य (*iṃdrasya*)—of Indra
- अवद्यं (*avadyaṃ*)—the sin in the form of brahmin-slaying and the like
- दिधिषंते (*didhiṣaṃte*)—they bear (in the form of foam)
- मम (*mama*)—my
- पुत्रः (*putraḥ*)—son, Indra
- महता (*mahatā*)—with the great
- वधेन (*vadhena*)—thunderbolt weapon
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—Vṛtra
- जघन्वान् (*jaghanvān*)—killed
- एतान् सिंधून् (*etān siṃdhūn*)—these waters
- वि असृजत् (*vi asṛjat*)—caused to be released to flow freely

Gist

The mantras in the form of 'nivid' are merely laudatory with regard to Indra. The waters bear Indra's sin of brahmin-slaying and the like in the form of foam. My son Indra killed Vṛtra with the great thunderbolt, and released these waters so that they flow freely.

English translation

What do the sacred expiatory strains declare to me? the waters receive the reproach of Indra : my son has slain Vritra with the mighty thunder- bolt : he has set those rivers free.

Special Topics

For a detailed account of Indra's slaying of the demon Vṛtra, the consequent incurring of the fault of brahmin-slaying by Indra, and the course of action Indra undertook to remove that fault, see Ṛ. Saṃ. Part 12, p. 627.

Ṛk 8

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

मम॑च्च॒न त्वा॑ युव॒तिः प॒रास॒ मम॑च्च॒न त्वा॑ कु॒षवा॑ ज॒गार॑ ।
मम॑च्चि॒दाप॒ः शिश॑वे ममृड्यु॒र्मम॑च्चि॒दिन्द्र॒ः सह॒सोद॑तिष्ठत् ॥ ८ ॥

> *mamaccana tvā yuvatiḥ parāsa mamaccana tvā kuṣavā jagāra |*
> *mamaccidāpaḥ śiśave mamṛḍyurmamaccidindraḥ sahasodatiṣṭhat ‖ 8 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> ममत् । चन । त्वा । युवतिः । पराआस । ममत् । चन । त्वा । कुषना । जगार ।
> वमत् । चित् । आपः । शिशवे । ममृड्युः । ममत् । चित् । इंद्रः । सहसा । उत् ।
> अतिष्ठत् ॥ ८ ॥

> *mamat | cana | tvā | yuvatiḥ | parāāsa | mamat | cana | tvā | kuṣanā | jagāra |*
> *vamat | cit | āpaḥ | śiśave | mamṛḍyuḥ | mamat | cit | iṃdraḥ | sahasā | ut |*
> *atiṣṭhat ‖ 8 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> सूक्तशेषेण ऋषिरिंद्रं स्तौति । हे इंद्र ममचन माद्यंत्येव । प्रमत्तैवेत्यर्थः । युवतिस्त्वदीया मातादितिस्ता त्वां परास । पराचिक्षेक । किंच कुषनानाम्मी काचिद्राक्षसी सा ममचन प्रमत्तैव त्वा त्वां जगार । गिरति स्म । हे इंद्र

> ममच्चित्प्रमद्यंत एवापः शिशवे जाताय तुभ्यं ममृड्युः । सुखयांचक्रुः ।
> ममच्चित् माद्यन्नेवेंद्रः सहसा स्वेन वीर्येणोदतिष्ठत् । सूतिकाग्रहाद्राक्षसीं
> बाधमानः सन् उत्कर्षेण तस्थौ ॥

> *sūktaśeṣeṇa ṛṣiriṃdraṃ stauti | he iṃdra mamaccana mādyaṃtyeva |*
> *pramattaivetyarthaḥ | yuvatistvadīyā mātāditistā tvāṃ parāsa |*
> *parācikṣeka | kiṃca kuṣanānāmmī kācidrākṣasī sā mamaccana*
> *pramattaiva tvā tvāṃ jagāra | girati sma | he iṃdra*
> *mamaccitpramadyaṃta evāpaḥ śiśave jātāya tubhyaṃ mamṛḍyuḥ |*
> *sukhayāṃcakruḥ |*
> *mamaccit mādyanneveṃdraḥ sahasā svena vīryeṇodatiṣṭhat |*
> *sūtikāgrahādrākṣasīṃ*
> *bādhamānaḥ san utkarṣeṇa tasthau ||*

Summary

With the rest of the sūkta the seer praises Indra. O Indra, "exulting", that is, in joy alone, the youthful mother, your mother Aditi, "cast you forth" (परास (*parāsa*)). Moreover, there is a certain demoness named Kuṣanā; exulting, in her joy, she swallowed you. O Indra, exulting indeed, the waters gave delight to you, the newborn child. Exulting, Indra rose up by his own strength, resisting the demoness who seized the newborn, and stood up in triumph.

Word-to-word meaning

- ममच्चन (*mamaccana*)—exultingly
- युवतिः (*yuvatiḥ*)—your mother Aditi
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- परास (*parāsa*)—bore
- ममच्चन (*mamaccana*)—exultingly
- कुषवा (*kuṣavā*)—the demoness named Kuṣavā
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- जगार (*jagāra*)—swallowed
- ममच्चित् (*mamaccit*)—from that very excess of joy
- आपः (*āpaḥ*)—the waters
- शिशवे (*śiśave*)—as soon as Indra was born
- ममृड्युः (*mamṛḍyuḥ*)—became givers of comfort

- ममच्चित् (*mamaccit*)—from joy
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- सहसा (*sahasā*)—by his own power
- उवतिष्ठत् (*uvatiṣṭhat*)—came out (breaking through the demoness)

Gist

The words of the mother of the seer Vāmadeva: O Indra, your youthful mother (Aditi) bore you in joy. In joy the demoness named Kuṣanā swallowed you. From that same excess of joy the waters became comfort-giving as soon as Indra was born. Indra too, joyful, broke through the demoness by his own power and came out.

English translation

Vamadeva speaks.—Exulting, the youthful mother brought you forth : exulting, Kushava swallowed you : exulting, the waters gave delight to the infant : Indra, exulting, rose up by his strength

Ṛk 9

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

ममं॑च्च॒न तें॑ मघव॒न्व्यं॑सो निविवि॒ध्वाँ अप॒ हनूं॑ ज॒घानं॑ ।
अधा॒ निविं॑द्ध॒ उत्तं॑रो बभू॒वाञ्छिरों॑ दा॒सस्य॒ सं पिं॑णग्व॒धेनं॑ ॥ ९ ॥

> *mamaccana te maghavanvyaṃso nivividhvā~ apa hanū jaghāna |*
> *adhā nividdha uttaro babhūvāñchiro dāsasya saṃ piṇagvadhena ‖ 9 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> सुमत् । चन । ते । मघवन् । विअंसः । निविविध्वान् । अप । हनू इति । जघान ।
> अध । निविद्धः । उत्तरः । बभूवान् । शिरः । दासस्य । सं । पिणक् । वधेन ॥ ९ ॥

> *sumat | cana | te | maghavan | viaṃsaḥ | nivividhvān | apa | hanū iti | jaghāna |*
> *adha | nividdaḥ | uttaraḥ | babhūvān | śiraḥ | dāsasya | saṃ | piṇak | vadhena ‖ 9 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे मघवन्थनवन्निंद्र ममच्चिन प्रमाद्यन्नेव व्यंसो नाम राक्षसो निविविध्वान् प्रविध्यन् ते हनू त्वदीये हनू मुखपार्श्वे अप जघान । अपहतवान् ।
> अध अथानंतरं हे इंद्र निविद्धो राक्षसेन ताडितस्त्वमुत्तरो व्यंसादधिकबलो
> बभूवान्भूतः सन् दासस्य क्षीणस्य व्यंसस्य शिरो वधेन वज्रेण सं पिणक् ।
> पिष्टवानसि ॥

> *he maghavanthanavanniṃdra mamaccina pramādyanneva vyaṃso nāma rākṣaso nivividhvān pravidhyan te hanū tvadīye hanū mukhapārśve apa jaghāna | apahatavān |*
> *adha athānaṃtaraṃ he iṃdra nividdo rākṣasena tāḍitastvamuttaro vyaṃsādadhikabalo*
> *babhūvānbhūtaḥ san dāsasya kṣīṇasya vyaṃsasya śiro vadhena vajreṇa saṃ piṇak |*
> *piṣṭavānasi ‖*

Summary

O wealthy Indra, exulting indeed, the demon named Vyaṃsa, striking, struck away your two jaws, the sides of your mouth. Then, O Indra, struck by the demon, you became superior, stronger than Vyaṃsa, and with the वध (*vadha*), the thunderbolt, you crushed the head of the exhausted दास (*dāsa*) Vyaṃsa.

Word-to-word meaning

- मघवन् (*maghavan*)—O wealthy Indra
- ममच्चन (*mamaccana*)—from excess of joy
- व्यंसः (*vyaṃsaḥ*)—the demon named Vyaṃsa
- निविविध्वान् (*nivividhvān*)—striking you
- ते (*te*)—your
- हनू (*hanū*)—on the cheeks
- अप जघान (*apa jaghāna*)—struck, dashing against

- अध (*adha*)—thereafter
- निविद्धः (*nividdaḥ*)—you, struck by him
- उत्तरः (*uttaraḥ*)—possessing greater strength than he
- बभूवान् (*babhūvān*)—having grown
- दासस्य (*dāsasya*)—of the asura Vyaṃsa
- शिरः (*śiraḥ*)—the head
- वधेन (*vadhena*)—with the thunderbolt, the instrument of slaying
- सं पिणक् (*saṃ piṇak*)—crushed to powder

Gist

O wealthy Indra, from excess of joy (from pride) the demon Vyaṃsa tried to strike you and dashed against your cheeks. Thereafter, struck by him, you grew stronger than he, and crushed the head of the asura Vyaṃsa with the thunderbolt, the instrument of slaying.

English translation

Vyansa, exulting and striking (hard blows) smote you, Maghavan, upon the jaw ; whereupon, being so smitten, you proved the stronger, and did crush the head of the slave with the thunderbolt.

Ṛk 10

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

गृ॒ष्टिः स॑सूव॒ स्थवि॑रं तवा॒गाम॑नाधृ॒ष्यं वृ॑ष॒भं तुम्र॒मि
न्द्र॑म् ।
अरी॑ळ्हं व॒त्सं च॒रथा॑य मा॒ता स्व॒यं गा॒तुं त॒न्वं॑ इ॒
च्छमा॑नम् ॥ १० ॥

> *gṛṣṭiḥ sasūva sthaviraṃ tavāgāmanādhṛṣyaṃ vṛṣabhaṃ tumramindram*
> |
> *arīḷhaṃ vatsaṃ carathāya mātā svayaṃ gātuṃ tanva icchamānam* ‖ *10* ‖

Pada-pāṭha

> गृष्टिः । ससूव । स्थविरं । तवागां । अनाधृष्य । वृषभं । तुम्रं । इंद्रं ।
> अरीळ्हं । वत्सं । चरथाय । माता । स्वयं । गातुं । तन्वे । इच्छमानं ॥ १० ॥

> *gṛṣṭiḥ | sasūva | sthaviraṃ | tavāgāṃ | anādhṛṣya | vṛṣabhaṃ | tumraṃ | iṃdraṃ |*
> *arīḷhaṃ | vatsaṃ | carathāya | mātā | svayaṃ | gātuṃ | tanve | icchamānaṃ ‖ 10 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> गृष्टिः काचिद्गौर्वत्सं यथा ससूव । सुषुवे । तथा मातेंद्रजनन्यदितिश्चरथाय स्वेच्छया
> संचरणायेंद्रं ससूव । सुषुवे । कीदृशमिंद्रं । स्थविरं वयसा
> प्रवृद्धं तवागां प्रवृद्धबलमनाधृष्ट्यं शत्रुभिरनभिभाव्यं वृषभं सेचनसमर्थं
> तुम्रं प्रेरकमरीळ्हं शत्रुभिरनभिभूतं स्वयं गातुमन्यनिरपेक्षगमनं तन्ने स्वशरीरायेच्छमानमिच्छंतं
> ॥

> *gṛṣṭiḥ kācidgaurvatsaṃ yathā sasūva | suṣuve | tathā*
> *mātemdrajananyaditiścarathāya svecchayā saṃcaraṇāyeṃdraṃ sasūva*
> *| suṣuve | kīdṛśamiṃdraṃ | sthaviraṃ vayasā*
> *pravṛddhaṃ tavāgāṃ pravṛddhabalamanādhṛṣṭyaṃ*
> *śatrubhiranabhibhāvyaṃ vṛṣabhaṃ secanasamarthaṃ*
> *tumraṃ prerakamarīḷhaṃ śatrubhiranabhibhūtaṃ svayaṃ*
> *gātumanyanirapekṣagamanaṃ tanne svaśarīrāyecchamānamicchaṃtaṃ*
> *‖*

Summary

As a heifer bears a calf, so the mother, Aditi, Indra's mother, bore Indra for roaming at will. What sort of Indra? स्थविरं (*sthaviraṃ*): grown mature in age; तवागां (*tavāgāṃ*): of grown strength; अनाधृष्यं (*anādhṛṣyaṃ*): not to be overcome by enemies; वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*): able to shower; तुम्रं (*tumraṃ*): impelling; अरीळ्हं (*arīḷhaṃ*): not overcome by enemies; स्वयं गातुं (*svayaṃ gātuṃ*): going of himself, independent of others; and wishing it for his own body.

Word-to-word meaning

- गृष्टिः (*gṛṣṭiḥ*)—a well-nourished heifer
- वत्सं (*vatsaṃ*)—a calf

- ससूव (*sasūva*)—as having borne
- माता (*mātā*)—Indra's mother Aditi
- स्थविरं (*sthaviraṃ*)—one grown in age
- तवागां (*tavāgāṃ*)—one of great strength
- अनाधृष्यं (*anādhṛṣyaṃ*)—one not defeated by enemies
- वृषभं (*vṛṣabhaṃ*)—the fulfiller of desires
- तुम्रं (*tumraṃ*)—the impeller of all
- अरीळ्हं (*arīḷhaṃ*)—the unobstructed
- स्वयं गातुं (*svayaṃ gātuṃ*)—one who roams at will
- तन्ने इच्छमानं (*tanne icchamānaṃ*)—one intent on protecting his own body
- इंद्रं (*iṃdraṃ*)—Indra
- चरथाय (*carathāya*)—for roaming at will
- ससूव (*sasūva*)—bore

Gist

As a well-nourished heifer bears her calf, Aditi, Indra's mother, bore for roaming at will Indra, who is mature in age, of great strength, undefeated by enemies, the fulfiller of desires, the impeller of all, unobstructed, a roamer at will, and intent on protecting his own body.

English translation

As a heifer bears a calf, his mother, (Aditi) bore Indra, mature (in years) strong. irresistible, vigorous, energetic, invincible, (destined) to follow his own course, heedful in his person.

Ṛk 11

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

उ॒त मा॒ता म॑हि॒षमन्व॑वेनद॒मी त्वा॑ जहति पुत्र दे॒वाः ।
अथा॑ब्रवीद्वृ॒त्रमिन्द्रो॑ हनि॒ष्यन्सखे॑ विष्णो वित॒रं वि क्र॑मस्व ॥ ११ ॥

> *uta mātā mahiṣamanvavenadamī tvā jahati putra devāḥ |*
> *athābravīdvṛtramindro haniṣyansakhe viṣṇo vitaraṃ vi kramasva ‖ 11 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> उत । माता । महिषं । अनु । अवेनत् । अमी इति । त्वा । जहति । पुत्र । देवाः ।
> अथ । अब्रवीत् । वृत्रं । इंद्रः । हनिष्यत् । सखे । विष्णो इति । वितरं । वि ।
> क्रमस्व ॥ ११ ॥

> *uta | mātā | mahiṣaṃ | anu | avenat | amī iti | tvā | jahati | putra | devāḥ |*
> *atha | abravīt | vṛtraṃ | iṃdraḥ | haniṣyat | sakhe | viṣṇo iti | vitaraṃ | vi |*
> *kramasva ‖ 11 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> उतापि च हे मदीय पुत्रेंद्र अमी वह्नादयो देवास्ता त्वां जहति ।
> त्यजंति । इत्युक्तवतींद्रस्य मातादितिरिंद्रं महिषं महांतं । महिष इति महन्नामैतत् । अन्ववेनत् । अयाचत । अथानंतरं हे विष्णो व्यापनशील हे सखे
> मित्रभूत हरे त्वं वृत्रं हनिष्यन् हंतुमिच्छन् वितरं वि क्रमस्व । अतिपराक्रमा
> भवेतींद्रो विष्णुमब्रवीत् । उवाच ॥

> *utāpi ca he madīya putreṃdra amī vahnādayo devāstā tvāṃ jahati |*
> *tyajaṃti | ityuktavatīṃdrasya mātāditiriṃdraṃ mahiṣaṃ mahāṃtaṃ |*
> *mahiṣa iti mahannāmaitat | anvavenat | ayācata | athānaṃtaraṃ he*
> *viṣṇo vyāpanaśīla he sakhe*

> *mitrabhūta hare tvaṃ vṛtraṃ haniṣyan haṃtumicchan vitaraṃ vi*
> *kramasva | atiparākramā*
> *bhavetīṃdro viṣṇumabravīt | uvāca ‖*

Summary

"And, O my son Indra, these gods, Agni and the rest, forsake you": having said this, Indra's mother Aditi implored Indra, the महिष (*mahiṣa*), the great one (mahiṣa is a name meaning "great"); अन्ववेनत् (*anvavenat*) means "she begged". Thereafter Indra said to Viṣṇu: "O Viṣṇu, the all-pervading, O friend, O Hari who are a companion, wishing to slay Vṛtra, stride out beyond (all others); be exceedingly valiant."

Word-to-word meaning

- उत (*uta*)—and
- पुत्र (*putra*)—O Indra
- अमिः देवाः (*amiḥ devāḥ*)—these gods, Agni and the rest
- त्वा (*tvā*)—you
- जहति (*jahati*)—if they abandon (leave)
- माता (*mātā*)—the mother Aditi
- महिषं (*mahiṣaṃ*)—the great Indra
- अन्ववेनत् (*anvavenat*)—asked
- अथ (*atha*)—thereafter
- इंद्रः (*iṃdraḥ*)—Indra
- विष्णुं (*viṣṇuṃ*)—to Viṣṇu
- सखे (*sakhe*)—O friend
- विष्णो (*viṣṇo*)—O Viṣṇu, the all-pervading
- वृत्रं (*vṛtraṃ*)—Vṛtra the asura
- हनिष्यन् (*haniṣyan*)—wishing to kill
- वितरं (*vitaraṃ*)—exceedingly
- वि क्रमस्व (*vi kramasva*)—"become valiant," said
- अब्रवीत् (*abravīt*)—he said[?471]

Gist

Aditi asked: "O Indra, my son, have the gods, Agni and the rest, abandoned your friendship?" Immediately Indra said to Viṣṇu: "O friend Viṣṇu, you are all-pervading and a well-wisher to me. Wishing to slay the asura Vṛtra, gain exceeding valour."

English translation

His mother inquired of the mighty Indra-have these deities deserted you, my son? then Indra said-Vishnu, my friend, (if you) purpose slaying Vritra, exert your greatest prowess.

Ṛk 12

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

कस्ते॑ मा॒तरं॑ वि॒धवा॑मचक्रच्छ॒युं कस्त्वाम॑जिघांस॒च्चरं॑न्तम् ।
कस्ते॑ दे॒वो अधि॑ मार्डी॒क आ॑सी॒द्यत्प्राक्षि॑णाः पि॒तरं॑ पा॒दगृह्य॑ ॥ १२ ॥

> *kaste mātaraṃ vidhavāmacakracchayuṃ kastvāmajighāṃsaccarantam |*
> *kaste devo adhi mārḍīka āsīdyatprākṣiṇāḥ pitaraṃ pādagṛhya ‖ 12 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> कः । ते । मातरं । विधवां । अचक्रत् । शयुं । कः । त्वां । अजिघांसत् । चरंतं ।
> कः । ते । देवः । अधि । मार्डीके । आसीत् । यत् । प्र । अक्षिणाः । पितरं । पादगृह्य ॥ १२ ॥

> *kaḥ | te | mātaraṃ | vidhavāṃ | acakrat | śayuṃ | kaḥ | tvāṃ | ajighāṃsat | caraṃtaṃ |*
> *kaḥ | te | devaḥ | adhi | mārḍīke | āsīt | yat | pra | akṣiṇāḥ | pitaraṃ | pādagṛhya ‖ 12 ‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> हे इंद्र यद्यस्मात्कारणात्पितुः सकाशाज्जनिष्यमाणाद्भीतस्त्वं त्वदीयं
> पितरं पादगृह्य पादेषु गृहीत्वा प्राक्षिणाः । प्रकर्षणावधीः । तस्मात्कारणात्ते
> त्वत्तोऽन्यः को देवो मातरं स्वकीयजननीं विधवां पितृवधेन पतिरहितामकच्रत् । अकरोत् ।
> कस्त्वत्तोऽन्यः शयुं शयानं चरंतं जागृतं ना त्वामजिघांसत् । हंतुमैच्छत् । ते त्वत्तोऽन्यः को
> देवो मार्डीके प्रजानां सुखकरणेऽधि अधिक आसीत् । अयमर्थ ऋक्सामे वै देवेभ्य
> इत्यनुवाके यज्ञो
> दक्षिणामभ्यध्यायदित्यादिब्राह्मणेन । तै. सं. ६–१–३–६ । तैत्तिरीयकैर्बहुधा
> प्रपंचितः ॥

> *he iṃdra yadyasmātkāraṇātpituḥ sakāśājjaniṣyamāṇādbhītasvaṃ tvadīyaṃ*
> *pitaraṃ pādagṝhya pādeṣu gṝhītvā prākṣiṇāḥ | prakarṣaṇāvadhīḥ | tasmātkāraṇātte*
> *tvatto 'nyaḥ ko devo mātaraṃ svakīyajananīṃ vidhavāṃ pitṛvadhena patirahitāmakacrat | akarot | kastvatto 'nyaḥ śayuṃ śayānaṃ caraṃtaṃ jāgṛtaṃ nā tvāmajighāṃsat | haṃtumaicchat | te tvatto 'nyaḥ ko devo mārḍīke prajānāṃ sukhakaraṇe 'dhi adhika āsīt | ayamartha ṛksāme vai devebhya ityanuvāke yajño*
> *dakṣiṇāmabhyadhyāyadityādibrāhmaṇena | tai. saṃ. 6-1-3-6 | taittirīyakairbahudhā*
> *prapaṃcitaḥ ‖*

Summary

Sāyaṇa says: O Indra, because you, afraid of the one who was about to be born from your father's side, seized your father by the feet and struck him down (प्राक्षिणाः (*prākṣiṇāḥ*), "you killed by crushing"), for that reason what god other than you made his own mother a widow, bereft of her husband through the killing of the father? Who other than you wished to kill you, whether lying down or walking about, that is, awake? What god other than you was greater in making the creatures happy (मार्डीके (*mārḍīke*))? This meaning is elaborated in many ways by the Taittirīyas in the Brāhmaṇa beginning ऋक्सामे वै देवेभ्य (*ṛksāme vai devebhya*), in the anuvāka and in the passage *yajño dakṣiṇāmabhyadhyāyat* and so on (Tai. Saṃ. 6-1-3-6).

Word-to-word meaning

- यत् (*yat*)—for which reason
- पितरं (*pitaraṃ*)—your father
- पादगृह्य (*pādagṛhya*)—seizing and dragging by the leg
- प्राक्षिणाः (*prākṣiṇāḥ*)—you felled and killed (therefore)
- ते (*te*)—other than you
- कः (*kaḥ*)—which deity indeed
- मातरं (*mātaraṃ*)—his mother
- विधवां (*vidhavāṃ*)—as a widow
- अचक्रत् (*acakrat*)—could make
- कः (*kaḥ*)—who other than you
- शयुं (*śayuṃ*)—lying asleep
- चरंतं (*caraṃtaṃ*)—and moving about
- त्वां (*tvāṃ*)—you
- अजिघांसत् (*ajighāṃsat*)—would wish to kill?
- ते (*te*)—other than you
- कः देवः (*kaḥ devaḥ*)—which deity indeed
- मार्डिके(*mārḍike*)—as a bringer of happiness to the creatures
- अधि आसीत् (*adhi āsīt*)—surpasses you

Gist

O Indra, since you yourself seized your father by the leg, dragged and thrust him down and killed him, no one but you is capable of such a deed. Therefore no one except you can make his own mother a widow. Who indeed could kill you, whether you are lying asleep or moving about? Which god other than you could have greater power than you to be the giver of happiness to the creatures?

English translation

Who has made your mother a widow? who has sought to slay the sleeping and the waking? what deity has been more gracious than you, since you have slain the father, having seized him by the foot ?

Ṛk 13

Saṃhitā-pāṭha

अव॑र्त्या॒ शुन॑ आ॒न्त्राणि॑ पेचे॒ न दे॒वेषु॑ विविदे मर्डि॒तार॑म् ।
अप॑श्यं जा॒याम॒म॑हीयमाना॒मधा॑ मे श्ये॒नो मध्वा ज॑भार ॥ १३ ॥

> *avartyā śuna āntrāṇi pece na deveṣu vivide marḍitāram |*
> *apaśyaṃ jāyāmamahīyamānāmadhā me śyeno madhvā jabhāra ‖ 13 ‖*

Pada-pāṭha

> अवर्त्या । शुनः । आंत्राणि । पेचे । न । देवेषु । विविदे । मर्डितारं ।
> अपश्यं । जायां । अमहीयमानां । अध । मे । श्वेनः । मधु । आ । जभार ॥ १३॥

> *avartyā | śunaḥ | āṃtrāṇi | pece | na | deveṣu | vivide | marḍitāraṃ |*
> *apaśyaṃ | jāyāṃ | amahīyamānāṃ | adha | me | śvenaḥ | madhu | ā |*
> *jabhāra ‖ 13‖*

Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya — Sāyaṇa's Explanation

> अनया वामदेवः स्वकीयं दारिद्र्यं सूचयन्निंद्रस्योत्कर्षमाह । वामदेवोऽहमवर्त्या
> जीवनोपायराहित्येन शुनः शुनकसंबंधीन्यांत्राणि पुरीतंति

> *anayā vāmadevaḥ svakīyaṃ dāridryaṃ sūcayanniṃdrasyotkarṣamāha |*
> *vāmadevo 'hamavartyā jīvanopāyarāhityena śunaḥ*
> *śunakasaṃbaṃdhīnyāṃtrāṇi purītaṃti*

> पेचे । अपचं । देवेषु द्योतमानेषु वह्न्यादिषु मध्य इंद्रादन्यं मर्डितारं
> सुखयितारं न विविदे । न लेभे । किंच जायां स्वकीयां भार्यामिमहीयमानामश्लाघनीयामपश्यं
> । अद्राक्षं । अध अथानंतरं श्येनः श्येनवच्छीफुगामींद्रो मे मह्यं मधु मधुरोपेतमुदकमा जभार
> । आजहार ॥

> *pece | apacaṃ | deveṣu dyotamāneṣu vahnyādiṣu madhya iṃdrādanyaṃ*
> *marḍitāraṃ*
> *sukhayitāraṃ na vivide | na lebhe | kiṃca jāyāṃ svakīyāṃ*

> *bhāryāmamahīyamānāmaślāghanīyāmapaśyaṃ | adrākṣaṃ | adha athānaṃtaraṃ śyenaḥ śyenavacchīphugāmīṃdro me mahyaṃ madhu madhuropetamudakamā jabhāra | ājahāra ||*

Summary

With this verse Vāmadeva, indicating his own poverty, proclaims Indra's pre-eminence. "I, Vāmadeva, for lack of any means of livelihood, cooked (पेचे (*pece*)) the entrails of a dog, the intestines (पुरीतंति (*purītaṃti*)) belonging to a dog."

"I cooked (अपचं (*apacaṃ*)). Among the shining gods, Agni and the rest, I found no comforter, no giver of happiness, other than Indra. Moreover I saw my own wife disrespected, not praised. Then Indra, swift-going like a falcon, brought to me sweet water, water endowed with sweetness."

Word-to-word meaning

- अवर्त्या (*avartyā*)—by reason of poverty
- शुनः (*śunaḥ*)—of a dog
- आंत्राणि (*āṃtrāṇi*)—the entrails
- पेचे (*pece*)—I cooked
- देवेषु (*deveṣu*)—among the shining gods
- मर्डितारं (*marḍitāraṃ*)—any deity who gives happiness
- न विविदे (*na vivide*)—I did not obtain
- जायां (*jāyāṃ*)—my wife
- अमहीयमानां (*amahīyamānāṃ*)—as disregarded
- अपश्यं (*apaśyaṃ*)—I saw
- अध (*adha*)—afterwards
- श्येनं (*śyenaṃ*)—Indra, swift-going like a falcon
- मे (*me*)—to me
- मधु (*madhu*)—water full of sweetness
- आ जभार (*ā jabhāra*)—brought and gave

Gist

The words of the seer Vāmadeva: By reason of poverty I cooked the entrails of a dog. Among the shining gods I found no deity who gives happiness. And for that same reason I saw my wife disrespected. Afterwards Indra, swift-going like a falcon, brought me water full of sweetness.

English translation

In extreme destitution I have cooked the entrails of a dog, I have not found a comforter among the gods. I have beheld my wife disrespected : then the falcon (Indra) has brought to me sweet water.

Special Topics

Having spoken thus, he told of the hardship he had suffered. Living in extreme poverty and finding no food to eat, I had to cook and eat the entrails of a dog (entrails of a dog), that is, its flesh, which no one eats, that is, which is forbidden. Because of this poverty of mine I had to see the loss of honour of my wife. Then Indra, looking on me with a gracious eye, gave me water full of sweetness and consoled me, so he says.

This last Ṛk does not relate to the birth of the seer Vāmadeva. It is a statement made when Vāmadeva had grown up, matured, and was experiencing hardships and pleasures. Therefore how this Ṛk came to be included in this sūkta cannot be said.

Closing verses: वेदार्थस्य प्रकाशेन तमो हार्दं निवारयन् । प्रमथांश्च तुरो देयाद्विद्यातीर्थमहेश्वरः ॥ (*vedārthasya prakāśena tamo hārdaṃ nivārayan | pramathāṃśca turo deyādvidyātīrthamaheśvaraḥ ‖*)

इति श्रीमद्राजाधिराजपरमेश्वरवैदिकमार्गप्रवर्तक श्रीवीरबुक्कभूपालसाम्राज्यधुरंधरेण सायणाचार्येण विरचिते माधवीये वेदार्थप्रकाशे ऋक्संहिताभाष्ये तृतीयाष्टके पंचमोऽध्यायः समाप्तः ॥ (*iti śrīmadrājādhirājaparameśvaravaidikamārgapravartaka śrīvīrabukkabhūpālasāmrājyadhuraṃdhareṇa sāyaṇācāryeṇa viracite mādhavīye vedārthaprakāśe ṛksaṃhitābhāṣye tṛtīyāṣṭake paṃcamo 'dhyāyaḥ samāptaḥ* ‖) ॥ ओं तत्स्यत् ॥ (‖ *oṃ tatsyat* ‖)

Here ends the fifth chapter in the third Aṣṭaka of the Ṛgveda Saṃhitā, with Śrī Sāyaṇa's commentary and a Kannada translation.

यदक्षरपदभ्रष्टं मात्राहीनं त. यद्भवेत् । तत्सर्वं क्षम्यतां देव वागीश्वर नमोऽस्तु ते ॥ (*yadakṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ ta. yadbhavet | tatsarvaṃ kṣamyatāṃ deva vāgīśvara namo 'stu te ‖*)

शुभं शुभयात् (*śubhaṃ śubhayāt*) मंगळं (*maṃgaḷaṃ*)